

THE COMPLETE WORKS OF FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE

A Compilation of Translations

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NACHLASS

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INTRODUCTION

This volume collects Friedrich Nietzsche's published works and a selection of his posthumous fragments (the *Nachlass*) in English translation. The translations have been chosen for their fidelity to Nietzsche's voice — his bite, his physiological concreteness, his aristocratic radicalism — rather than for scholarly consensus or editorial safety.

The published works are presented in chronological order, from *The Birth of Tragedy* (1872) through the *Dithyrambs of Dionysus* (1888), the last thing Nietzsche wrote before his collapse. Each work is credited to its translator.

The *Nachlass* presents a harder question. Nietzsche abandoned his plan for a magnum opus called *The Will to Power* in 1888, and the posthumous compilation bearing that title — assembled by his sister and later re-edited by Walter Kaufmann — is a construction, not a book Nietzsche authorised. For the late notebooks (1885–1888), Kaufmann's *Will to Power* is included here as a provisional map of the terrain, with the recognition that the Stanford critical edition will eventually supersede it. The Stanford volumes that were available at the time of compilation (vols. 14 and 16) appear in full.

Three notes on the translations:

Ian Johnston — the doctrinal core (*Birth of Tragedy*, *Beyond Good and Evil*, *Genealogy of Morals*). His public-domain translations are chosen for fidelity, not polish. They do not flinch.

R.J. Hollingdale — the middle and late periods (*Untimely Meditations*, *Human All Too Human*, *Daybreak*, *Twilight*, *Antichrist*, *Ecce Homo*, *Dithyrambs*). Hollingdale's Nietzsche has bite without editorial softening. He is the translator who lets Nietzsche's spite stay in the room.

R.J. Hollingdale — Thus Spoke Zarathustra. Lean, direct, and unflinching. His Zarathustra strikes like a hammer — no poetic softening, no academic hedging. The *Übermensch* is "the Superman" and "down-going" is the path, not "going-under."

Part I

The Birth of Tragedy

1872 — *Translated by Ian Johnston*

THE BIRTH OF TRAGEDY AN ATTEMPT AT SELF-CRITICISM(1)
Whatever might have been the basis for this dubious book, it must have been a question of the utmost importance and charm, as well as a deeply personal one at the time—testimony to that effect is the period in which it arose, in spite of which it arose, that disturbing era of the Franco-Prussian war of 1870-71. While the thunderclap of the Battle of Wörth was reverberating across Europe, the meditative lover of enigmas whose lot it was to father this book sat somewhere in a corner of the Alps, extremely reflective and perplexed, thus simultaneously very distressed and carefree, and wrote down his thoughts about the Greeks—the kernel of that odd and difficult book to which this later preface (or postscript) should be dedicated.(2) A few weeks after that, he found himself under the walls of Metz, still not yet free of the question mark which he had set down beside the alleged “serenity” of the Greeks and of Greek culture, until, in that month of the deepest tension, as peace was being negotiated in Versailles, he finally came to peace with himself and, while slowly recovering from an illness he had brought back home with him from the field, finished composing the Birth of Tragedy out of the Spirit of Music.(3)—From music? Music and tragedy? The Greeks and the music of tragedy? The Greeks and the art work of pessimism? The most successful, most beautiful, most envied people, those with the most encouraging style of life so far—the Greeks? How can this be? Did they of all people need tragedy? Even more—art? What for—Greek art? One can guess from all this just where the great question mark about the worth of existence was placed. Is pessimism necessarily the sign of collapse, destruction, of disaster, of the exhausted and enfeebled instincts—as it was with the Indians, as it is now, to all appearances, among us, the “modern” peoples and Europeans? Is there a pessimism of strength? An intellectual inclination for what in existence is hard, dreadful, evil, problematic, emerging from what is healthy, from overflowing well being, from living existence to the full? Is there perhaps a way of suffering from the very fullness of life? A tempting courage of the keenest sight which demands what is terrible as the enemy, the worthy enemy, against which it can test its power, from which it wants to learn what “to fear” means? What does the tragic myth mean precisely for the Greeks of the best, strongest, and bravest age? What about that tremendous phenomenon of the Dionysian?(4) And what about

what was born out of the Dionysian—the tragedy? And by contrast, what are we to make of what killed tragedy—Socratic morality, dialectic, the satisfaction and serenity of the theoretical man?(5)How about that? Could not this very Socratism [Sokratismus] be a sign of collapse, exhaustion, sickness, the anarchic dissolution of the instincts? And could the “Greek serenity” of later Greek periods be only a red sunset? Could the Epicurean will hostile to pessimism be merely the prudence of a suffering man?(6) And even science itself, our science—indeed, what does all science in general mean considered as a symptom of life? What is the point of all that science and, even more serious, where did it come from? What about that? Is scientific scholarship perhaps only a fear and an excuse in the face of pessimism? A delicate self-defence against—the Truth? And speaking morally, something like cowardice and falsehood? Speaking unmorally, a clever trick.(7) O Socrates, Socrates, was that perhaps your secret? O you secretive ironist, was that perhaps your—irony?— 2 What I managed to seize upon at that time, something fearful and dangerous, was a problem with horns, not necessarily a bull exactly, but in any event a new problem; today I would state that it was the problem of science itself—science for the first time grasped as problematic, as dubious. But that book, in which my youthful courage and suspicion then spoke, what an impossible book had to grow out of a task so contrary to the spirit of youth! Created out of merely premature, really immature personal experiences, which all lay close to the threshold of something communicable, built on the basis of art—for the problem of science cannot be understood on the basis of science—a book perhaps for artists with analytical tendencies and a capacity for retrospection (that means for exceptions, a type of artist whom it is necessary to seek out and whom one never wants to look for . . .), full of psychological innovations and artists’ secrets, with an artist’s metaphysics in the background, a youthful work, full of the spirit of youth and the melancholy of youth, independent, defiantly self-sufficient, even where it seemed to bow down with special reverence to an authority, in short, a first work also in every bad sense of the word, afflicted, in spite of the problem better suited for old men, with every fault of youth, above all with its “excessive verbiage” and its “storm and stress.” On the other hand, looking back on the success the book had (especially with the great artist to whom it addressed itself, as if in a conversation, that is, with Richard Wagner), the book proved itself—I mean it was the sort of book which at any rate was effective enough among “the best people of its time.”(8) For that reason the book should at this point be handled with some consideration and discretion. However, I do not want totally to hide how unpleasant the book seems to me now, how strangely after sixteen years it stands there in front of me—in front of an older man, a hundred times more discriminating, but with eyes which have not grown colder in the slightest and which have themselves not become estranged from the work which that bold

book dared to approach for the first time: to look at science from the perspective of the artist, but to look at art from the perspective of life. 3 Let me say again: today for me it is an impossible book—I call it something poorly written, ponderous, embarrassing, with fantastic and confused imagery, sentimental, here and there so saccharine it is effeminate, uneven in tempo, without any impulse for logical clarity, extremely self-confident and thus dispensing with evidence, even distrustful of the relevance of evidence, like a book for the initiated, like “Music” for those baptized into music, those who are bound together from the start in secret and esoteric aesthetic experiences as a secret sign recognized among blood relations in artibus [in the arts]—an arrogant and rhapsodic book, which right from the start hermetically sealed itself off from the profanum vulgus [profane rabble] of the “educated,” even more than from the “people,” but a book which, as its effect proved and continues to prove, must also understand this issue well enough to search out its fellow rhapsodists and to tempt them to new secret pathways and dancing grounds. At any rate, here a strange voice spoke—people admitted that with as much curiosity as aversion—the disciple of an as yet “unknown God,” who momentarily hid himself under the hood of a learned man, under the gravity and dialectical solemnity of the German man, even under the bad manners of a follower of Wagner. Here was a spirit with alien, even nameless, needs, a memory crammed with questions, experiences, secret places, beside which the name Dionysus was written like one more question mark. Here spoke—so people said to themselves suspiciously—something like a mystic and an almost maenad-like soul, which stammered with difficulty and arbitrarily, in a foreign language, as it were, almost uncertain whether it wanted to communicate something or hide itself.(9) This “new soul” should have sung, not spoken! What a shame that I did not dare to utter as a poet what I had to say at that time; perhaps I might have been able to do that! Or at least as a philologist—even today in this area almost everything is still there for philologists to discover and dig up! Above all, the issue that there is a problem right here—and that the Greeks will continue to remain, as before, entirely unknown and unknowable as long as we have no answer to the question, “What is Dionysian?” . . . 4 Indeed, what is Dionysian?—This book offers an answer to that question—a “knowledgeable person” speaks there, the initiate and disciple of his god. Perhaps I would now speak with more care and less eloquently about such a difficult psychological question as the origin of tragedy among the Greeks. A basic issue is the relationship of the Greeks to pain, the degree of their sensitivity—did this relationship remain constant? Or did it turn itself around?—That question whether their constantly stronger desire for beauty, for festivals, entertainments, and new cults really arose out of some lack, out of deprivation, out of melancholy, out of pain. For if we assume that this particular claim is true—and Pericles, or, rather, Thucydides, in the great Funeral Oration gives us to

understand that it is—where then must that contradictory desire stem from, which appears earlier than the desire for beauty, namely, the desire for the ugly, the good strong willing of the ancient Hellenes for pessimism, for tragic myth, for pictures of everything fearful, evil, enigmatic, destructive, and fateful as the basis of existence?(10) Where then must tragedy have come from? Perhaps out of joy, out of power, out of overflowing health, out of overwhelming fullness? And psychologically speaking, what then is the meaning of that madness out of which tragic as well as comic art grew, the Dionysian madness? What? Is madness perhaps not necessarily the symptom of degradation, of collapse, of cultural decadence? Are there perhaps—a question for doctors who treat madness—neuroses associated with health? With the youth of a people and with youthfulness? What is revealed in that synthesis of god and goat in the satyr? Out of what personal experience, what impulse, did the Greek have to imagine the Dionysian enthusiast and original man as a satyr? And so far as the origin of the tragic chorus is concerned, in those centuries when the Greek body flourished and the Greek soul bubbled over with life, were there perhaps endemic raptures? Visions and hallucinations which entire communities, entire cultural bodies, shared? How's that? What if it were the case that the Greeks, right in the richness of their youth, had the will for the tragic and were pessimists? What if it was clearly lunacy, to use a saying from Plato, which brought the (T)greatest blessings throughout Greece? And, on the other hand, what if, to turn the issue around, it was precisely during the period of their dissolution and weakness that the Greeks became constantly more optimistic, more superficial, more hypocritical, and with a greater lust for logic and rational understanding of the world, as well as “more cheerful” and “more scientific”? What's this? In spite of all “modern ideas” and the prejudices of democratic taste, could the victory of optimism, the developing hegemony of reasonableness, of practical and theoretical utilitarianism, as well as democracy itself, which occurs in the same period, perhaps be a symptom of failing power, of approaching old age, of physiological exhaustion, rather than pessimism? Was Epicurus an optimist—precisely because he was suffering?—We see that this book was burdened with an entire bundle of difficult questions—let us add its most difficult question: What, from the point of view of (T)living, does morality mean? . . . 5 The preface to Richard Wagner already proposed that art—and not morality—was the essential metaphysical human activity; in the book itself there appears many times over the suggestive statement that the existence of the world is justified only as an aesthetic phenomenon. In fact, the entire book recognizes only an artist's sense and—a deeper meaning under everything that happens—a “God,” if you will, but certainly only a totally unthinking and amoral artist-God, who in creation as in destruction, in good things as in bad, desires to become aware of his own pleasures and autocratic power equally, a God who, as he creates worlds,

rids himself of the distress of fullness and superfluity, of the suffering of pressing internal contradictions. The world is at every moment the attained redemption of God, as the eternally changing, eternally new vision of the one who suffers most, who is the most rent with contradictions, the most inconsistent, who knows how to save himself only in appearances. People may call this entire artistic metaphysics arbitrary, pointless, and fantastic—the essential point about it is that it already betrays a spirit which will at some point risk everything to stand against the moralistic interpretation and meaningfulness of existence. Here is announced, perhaps for the first time, a pessimism “beyond good and evil”; here is expressed in word and formula that “perversity in belief” against which Schopenhauer never grew tired of hurling his angriest curses and thunderbolts in advance—a philosophy which dares to place morality itself in the world of phenomena, to subsume it, not merely under the “visions” (in the sense of some idealistic terminus technicus [technical end point]) but under “illusions,” as an appearance, delusion, fallacy, interpretation, something made up, a work of art. (11) Perhaps we can best gauge the depth of this tendency hostile to morality from the careful and antagonistic silence with which Christianity is treated in the entire book—Christianity as the most excessively thorough elaboration of a moralistic theme which humanity up to this point has had available to listen to. To tell the truth, there is nothing which stands in greater opposition to the purely aesthetic interpretation and justification of the world, as it is taught in this book, than Christian doctrine, which is and wishes to be merely moralistic and which, with its absolute standards, beginning, for example, with its truthfulness of God, relegates art, every art, to the realm of lies—in other words, which denies art, condemns it, and passes sentence on it. Behind such a way of thinking and evaluating, which must be hostile to art, so long as it is in any way genuine, I always perceived also something hostile to life, the wrathful, vengeful aversion to life itself; for all life rests on appearance, art, illusion, optics, the need for perspective and for error. Christianity was from the start essentially and thoroughly life’s disgust and weariness with life, which only dressed itself up with, only hid itself in, only decorated itself with the belief in an “other” or “better” life. The hatred of the “world,” the curse against the emotions, the fear of beauty and sensuality, a world beyond created so that the world on this side might be more easily slandered, at bottom a longing for nothingness, for extinction, for rest, until the “Sabbath of all Sabbaths”—all that, as well as the absolute desire of Christianity to allow only moral values to count, has always seemed to me the most dangerous and the weirdest form of all possible manifestations of a “Will to Destruction,” at least a sign of the deepest illness, weariness, bad temper, exhaustion, and impoverishment in living—for in the eyes of morality (and particularly Christian morality, that is, absolute morality) life must be seen as constantly and inevitably wrong, because life is something

essentially amoral—hence, pressed down under the weight of contempt and eternal No’s, life must finally be experienced as something not worth desiring, as something inherently worthless. And what about morality itself? Might not morality be a “desire for the denial of life,” a secret instinct for destruction, a principle of decay, diminution, slander, a beginning of the end? And thus, the danger of dangers? . . . And so, my instinct at that time turned itself against morality in this questionable book, as an instinct affirming life, and invented for itself a fundamentally different doctrine and a totally opposite way of evaluating life, something purely artistic and anti-Christian. What should it be called? As a philologist and man of words, I baptized it, taking some liberties— for who knew the correct name of the Antichrist?—after the name of a Greek god: I called it the Dionysian.— 6 Do people understand the nature of the task I dared to touch on back then with this book? . . . How much I now regret the fact that at the time I did not yet have the courage (or the presumptuousness?) to allow myself in every respect a personal language for such an individual point of view and such daring exploits—that I sought laboriously to express strange new evaluations with formulas from Schopenhauer and Kant, something which basically went quite against the spirit of Kant and Schopenhauer, as well as against their tastes!(12) What then did Schopenhauer think about tragedy? He says, “What gives everything tragic its characteristic drive for elevation is the working out of the recognition that the world, that life, can provide no proper satisfaction, and thus our devotion to it is not worthwhile; the tragic spirit consists of that insight—it leads therefore to resignation” (The World as Will and Idea, II,3,37). O how differently Dionysus spoke to me! O how far from me then was precisely this whole doctrine of resignation! But there is something much worse about my book, something which I now regret even more than to have obscured and spoiled Dionysian premonitions with formulas from Schopenhauer: namely, that I generally ruined for myself the magnificent problem of the Greeks, as it arose in me, by mixing it up with the most modern issues! I regret that I tied myself to hopes where there was nothing to hope for, where everything indicated all too clearly an end point! That, on the basis of the most recent German music, I began to tell stories of the “German character,” as if that character might be just about to discover itself, to find itself again—and that at a time when the German spirit, which not so long before still had the desire to rule Europe and the power to assume leadership of Europe, was, as its final testament, simply abdicating forever and, beneath the ostentatious pretext of founding an empire, making the transition to a conciliatory moderation, to democracy and “modern ideas”! As a matter of fact, in the intervening years I have learned to think of that “German character” with a sufficient lack of hope and of mercy—similarly with contemporary German music, which is Romantic through and through and the most un-Greek of all possible art forms, and besides that, a first-rate corrupter of

the nerves, doubly dangerous among a people who love drink and esteem lack of clarity as a virtue, because that has the dual character of a drug which simultaneously intoxicates and befuddles the mind.—Of course, set apart from all the rash hopes and defective practical applications to present times with which I then spoiled my first book for myself, the great Dionysian question mark still remains as it is set out there, also in relation to music: How would one have to create a music which is no longer Romantic in origin, like the German—but Dionysian? 7 But, my dear sir, what in all the world is Romantic if your book is not? Can the deep hatred against “modernism,” “reality,” and “modern ideas” go any further than it does in your artists’ metaphysics— which would sooner still believe in nothingness or the devil than in the “here and now”? Does not a fundamental bass note of anger and desire for destruction rumble underneath all your contrapuntal vocal art and seductive sounds, a raging determination in opposition to everything “contemporary,” a desire which is not too distant from practical nihilism and which seems to say “Better that nothing were true than that you were right, than that your truth were correct!” Listen to yourself, my pessimistic gentleman and worshipper of art, listen with open ears to a single selected passage from your book, to that not ineloquent passage about the dragon slayer, which may sound like an incriminating pied piper to those with young ears and hearts. What? Is that not a true and proper Romantic declaration of 1830, under the mask of the pessimism of 1850, behind which is already playing the prelude to the usual Romantic finale—break, collapse, return, and prostration before an ancient belief, before the old God . . . What? Isn’t your book for pessimists itself an anti-Greek and Romantic piece, even something “as intoxicating as it is befuddling,” in any event, a narcotic, even a piece of music, German music? Listen to the following: “Let’s picture for ourselves a generation growing up with this fearlessness in its gaze, with this heroic push into what is tremendous; let’s picture for ourselves the bold stride of these dragon slayers, the proud audacity with which they turn their backs on all the doctrines of weakness associated with optimism, in order to live with resolution, fully and completely. Would it not be necessary that the tragic man of this culture, having trained himself for what is serious and frightening, desire a new art, the art of metaphysical consolation, the tragedy, as his own personal Helen of Troy, and to have to cry out with Faust: With my desire’s power, should I not call Into this life the fairest form of all?(13) “Would it not be necessary?” . . . No, three times no! You young Romantics: it should not be necessary! But it is very likely that things will end up like that—that you will end up like that—namely, “being consoled,” as it stands written, in spite of all the self-training for what is serious and frightening, “metaphysically consoled,” in short, the way Romantics finish up, as Christians. . . . No! You should first learn the art of consolation in this life—you should learn to laugh, my young friends, even if you wish to remain thoroughly

pessimistic. From that, as laughing people, some day or other perhaps you will for once ship all metaphysical consolation to the devil—and then away with metaphysics! Or, to speak the language of that Dionysian fiend called Zarathustra:(14) “Lift up your hearts, my brothers, high, higher! And for my sake don’t forget your legs as well! Raise up your legs, you fine dancers, and better yet, stand on your heads!” “This crown of the man who laughs, this crown wreathed with roses—I have placed this crown upon myself. I myself declare my laughter holy. Today I found no one else strong enough for that.” “Zarathustra the dancer, Zarathustra the light hearted, who beckons with his wings, a man ready to fly, hailing all birds, prepared and ready, a careless and blessed man.”—“Zarathustra the truth-teller, Zarathustra the true laugh, not an impatient man, not a man of absolutes, someone who loves jumps and leaps to the side—I myself crown myself!” “This crown of the laughing man, this crown of rose wreaths: you my brothers, I throw this crown to you! Laughter I declare sacred: you higher men, for my sake learn—to laugh!” Sils-Maria, Upper Engadine August 1886 PREFACE TO RICHARD WAGNER In order to keep far away from me all possible disturbances, agitation, and misunderstandings which the assembly of ideas in this piece of writing will bring about on account of the peculiar character of our aesthetic public, and also to be capable of writing a word of introduction to the book with the same contemplative joy which marks every page, the crystallization of good inspirational hours, I am imagining to myself the look with which you, my esteemed friend, will receive this work—how you, perhaps after an evening stroll in the winter snow, look at the unbound Prometheus on the title page, read my name, and are immediately convinced that, no matter what this text consists of, the writer has something serious and urgent to say, and that, in addition, in everything which he composed, he was conversing with you as with someone present and could write down only what was appropriate to such a presence. In this connection, you will remember that I gathered these ideas together at the same time that your marvellous commemorative volume on Beethoven appeared, that is, during the terror and grandeur of the war which had just broken out. Nevertheless, people would be wrong if this collection made them think of the contrast between patriotic excitement and aesthetic rapture, between a brave seriousness and a cheerful game. By actually reading this text, they should instead be astonished to recognize clearly the serious German problem which we have to deal with, the problem which we really placed right in the middle of German hopes, as its vortex and turning point. However, it will perhaps be generally offensive for these same people to see an aesthetic problem taken so seriously, if, that is, they are incapable of seeing art as anything more than a merry diversion, an easily dispensable bell-ringing in comparison with the “Seriousness of Existence,” as if no one understood what was involved in this contrast with such “Seriousness of

Existence.” For these earnest readers, let this serve as a caution: I am convinced that art is the highest task and the essential metaphysical capability of this life, in the sense of that man to whom I here, as to my sublime pioneer on this path, wish this writing to be dedicated. Basel, End of the Year 1871 THE BIRTH OF TRAGEDY 1 We will have achieved much for scientific study of aesthetics when we come, not merely to a logical understanding, but also to the certain and immediate apprehension of the fact that the further development of art is bound up with the duality of the Apollonian and the Dionysian, just as reproduction similarly depends upon the duality of the sexes, their continuing strife and only periodically occurring reconciliation. We take these names from the Greeks, who gave a clear voice to the profound secret teachings of their contemplative art, not in ideas, but in the powerfully clear forms of their divine world. With those two gods of art, Apollo and Dionysus, we establish our recognition that in the Greek world there exists a huge contrast, in origin and purposes, between the visual arts, the Apollonian, and the non-visual art of music, the Dionysian.(15) These two very different drives go hand in hand, for the most part in open conflict with each other and simultaneously provoking each other all the time to new and more powerful offspring, in order to perpetuate in them the contest of that opposition, which the common word “Art” only seems to bridge, until at last, through a marvellous metaphysical act of the Greek “will,” they appear paired up with each other and, as this pair, finally produce Attic tragedy, as much a Dionysian as an Apollonian work of art. In order to bring those two drives closer to us, let us think of them first as the separate artistic worlds of dream and of intoxication, physiological phenomena between which we can observe an opposition corresponding to the one between the Apollonian and the Dionysian. According to the idea of Lucretius, the marvellous divine shapes first stepped out before the mind of man in a dream.(16) It was in a dream that the great artist saw the delightful anatomy of superhuman existence, and the Greek poet, questioned about the secrets of poetic creativity, would have also recalled his dreams and given an explanation similar to the one Hans Sachs provides in *Die Meistersinger*.(17) My friend, that is precisely the poet’s work— To figure out his dreams, mark them down. Believe me, the truest illusion of mankind Is revealed to him in dreams: All poetic art and poeticizing Is nothing but interpreting true dreams. The beautiful appearance of the world of dreams, in whose creation each man is a complete artist, is the precondition of all plastic art, and also, in fact, as we shall see, an important part of poetry. We enjoy the form with an immediate understanding; every shape speaks to us; nothing is indifferent and unnecessary. For all the most intense life of this dream reality, we nevertheless have the shimmering sense of their illusory quality: That, at least, is my experience. For the frequency, indeed normality, of this response, I could point to many witnesses and the utterances of poets. Even the philosophical man

has the presentiment that under this reality in which we live and have our being lies hidden a second, totally different reality and that thus the former is an illusion. And Schopenhauer specifically designates as the trademark of philosophical talent the ability to recognize at certain times that human beings and all things are mere phantoms or dream pictures. Now, just as the philosopher behaves in relation to the reality of existence, so the artistically excitable man behaves in relation to the reality of dreams: he looks at them precisely and with pleasure, for from these pictures he fashions his interpretation of life; from these events he rehearses his life for himself. This is not merely a case of the agreeable and friendly images which he experiences in himself with a complete understanding; they also include what is serious, cloudy, sad, dark, sudden scruples, teasing accidents, nervous expectations, in short, the entire “divine comedy” of life, including the Inferno—all this moves past him, not just like a shadow play—for he lives and suffers in the midst of these scenes—and yet also not without that fleeting sense of illusion. And perhaps several people remember, like me, amid the dangers and terrors of a dream, successfully cheering themselves up by shouting: “It is a dream! I want to dream it some more!” I have also heard accounts of some people who had the ability to set out the causality of one and the same dream over three or more consecutive nights. These facts are clear evidence showing that our innermost beings, the secret underground in all of us, experiences its dreams with deep enjoyment and a sense of delightful necessity. In the same manner the Greeks expressed this joyful necessity of the dream experience in their Apollo. Apollo, as the god of all the plastic arts, is at the same time the god of prophecy. In accordance with the root meaning of his association with “brightness,” he is the god of light; he also rules over the beautiful appearance of the inner fantasy world. The higher truth, the perfection of this condition in contrast to the sketchy understanding of our daily reality, as well as the deep consciousness of a healing and helping nature in sleep and dreaming, is at the same time the symbolic analogy to the capacity to prophesy the truth, as well as to art in general, through which life is made possible and worth living. But also that delicate line which the dream image may not cross so that it does not work its effect pathologically—otherwise the illusion would deceive us as crude reality—that line must not be absent from the image of Apollo, that boundary of moderation, that freedom from more ecstatic excitement, that fully wise calm of the god of images. His eye must be “sun-like,” in keeping with his origin; even when he is angry and gazes with displeasure, the consecration of the beautiful illusion rests on him. And so concerning Apollo one could endorse, in an eccentric way, what Schopenhauer says of the man trapped in the veil of Maja: “As on the stormy sea which extends without limit on all sides, howling mountainous waves rise up and sink and a sailor sits in a row boat, trusting the weak craft, so, in the midst of a world of

torments, the solitary man sits peacefully, supported by and trusting in the principium individuationis [principle of individuation]" (World as Will and Idea, I.1.3).(18) In fact, we could say of Apollo that the imperturbable trust in that principle and the calm sitting still of the man caught up in it attained its loftiest expression in him, and we may even designate Apollo himself as the marvellous divine image of the principium individuationis, from whose gestures and gaze all the joy and wisdom of "illusion," together with its beauty, speak to us. In the same place Schopenhauer also described for us the tremendous awe that seizes a man when he suddenly doubts his ways of comprehending illusion, when the principle of reason, in any one of its forms, appears to suffer from an exception. If we add to this awe the ecstatic rapture, which rises up out of the same collapse of the principium individuationis from the innermost depths of a human being, indeed, from the innermost depths of nature, then we have a glimpse into the essence of the Dionysian, which is presented to us most closely through the analogy to intoxication. Either through the influence of narcotic drink, of which all primitive men and peoples speak in their hymns, or through the powerful coming on of spring, which drives joyfully through all of nature, that Dionysian excitement arises; as it intensifies, the subjective fades into complete forgetfulness of self. Even in the German Middle Ages, under the same power of Dionysus, constantly growing hordes thronged from place to place, singing and dancing; in these St. John's and St. Vitus's dances we recognize the Bacchic chorus of the Greeks once again, with its precursors in Asia Minor, right back to Babylon and the orgiastic Sacaea [riotous Babylonian festival]. There are people who, from a lack of experience or out of apathy, turn mockingly or pityingly away from such phenomena as from a "sickness of the people," with a sense of their own health. These poor people naturally do not have any sense of how deathly and ghost-like this very "health" of theirs sounds, when the glowing life of the Dionysian throng roars past them. Under the magic of the Dionysian, not only does the bond between man and man lock itself in place once more, but also nature itself, no matter how alienated, hostile, or subjugated, rejoices again in her festival of reconciliation with her prodigal son, man. The earth freely offers up her gifts, and the beasts of prey from the rocks and the desert approach in peace. The wagon of Dionysus is covered with flowers and wreaths; under his yolk stride panthers and tigers. If someone were to transform Beethoven's Ode to Joy into a painting and not restrain his imagination when millions of people sink dramatically into the dust, then we could come close to the Dionysian. Now the slave a free man; now all the stiff, hostile barriers break apart, those things which necessity and arbitrary power or "saucy fashion" have established between men. Now, with the gospel of world harmony, every man feels himself not only united with his neighbour, reconciled and fused together, but also as one with him, as if the veil of Maja had been ripped apart, with only scraps fluttering around in the

face of the mysterious primordial unity. Singing and dancing, man expresses himself as a member of a higher community: he has forgotten how to walk and talk and is on the verge of flying up into the air as he dances. The enchantment speaks out in his gestures. Just as the animals now speak and the earth gives milk and honey, so something supernatural also echoes out of him: he feels himself a god; he himself now moves in as lofty and ecstatic a way as he saw the gods move in his dream. The man is no longer an artist; he has become a work of art: the artistic power of all of nature, to the highest rhapsodic satisfaction of the primordial unity, reveals itself here in the transports of intoxication. The finest clay, the most expensive marble—man—is here worked and hewn, and the cry of the Eleusinian mysteries rings out to the chisel blows of the Dionysian world artist: “Do you fall down, you millions? World, do you have a sense of your creator?”(19) 2 Up to this point, we have considered the Apollonian and its opposite, the Dionysian, as artistic forces which break forth out of nature itself, without the mediation of the human artist, and in which the human artistic drives are for the time being satisfied directly—on the one hand, as a world of dream images, whose perfection has no connection with an individual’s high level of intellect or artistic education, on the other hand, as the intoxicating reality, which once again does not respect the individual, but even seeks to abolish the individual and to redeem him through a mystical feeling of collective unity. In comparison to these unmediated artistic states of nature, every artist is an “imitator,” and, in fact, is an artist either of Apollonian dream or Dionysian intoxication or, finally—as in Greek tragedy, for example— simultaneously an artist of intoxication and of dreams. As the last, it is possible for us to imagine how he sinks down in Dionysian drunkenness and mystical obliteration of the self, alone and apart from the rapturous choruses, and how, through the Apollonian effects of dream, his own state now reveals itself to him, that is, his unity with the innermost basis of the world, in a metaphorical dream picture. Having set out these general assumptions and comparisons, let us now approach the Greeks, in order to recognize to what degree and to what heights those artistic drives of nature were developed in them: in that way we will be in a position to understand more deeply and to assess the relationship of the Greek artist to his primordial images or, to use Aristotle’s expression, his “imitation of nature.” In spite of all their literature on dreams and numerous dream anecdotes, we can speak of the dreams of the Greeks only hypothetically, although with a fair degree of certainty. Given the incredibly clear and accurate plastic capability of their eyes, along with their intelligent and open love of colour, one cannot go wrong in assuming that, to the shame all those born later, their dreams also had a logical causality of lines and circumferences, colours, and groupings, a sequence of scenes rather like their best bas reliefs, whose perfection would certainly entitle us, if such a comparison were possible, to describe the dreaming Greek

man as Homer and Homer as a dreaming Greek man, in a deeper sense than when modern man, with respect to his dreams, has the temerity to compare himself with Shakespeare. On the other hand, we do not need to speak merely hypothetically when we are to expose the immense gap which separates the Dionysian Greeks from the Dionysian barbarians. In all quarters of the ancient world—setting aside here the newer worlds—from Rome to Babylon, we can confirm the existence of Dionysian celebrations, of a type, at best, related to the Greek type in much the same way as the bearded satyr, whose name and attributes are taken from the goat, is related to Dionysus himself. Almost everywhere, the central point of these celebrations consisted of an exuberant sexual promiscuity, whose waves flooded over all established family practices and its traditional laws. The very wildest bestiality of nature was here unleashed, creating that abominable mixture of lust and cruelty, which has always seemed to me the real “witches’ cauldron.” From the feverish excitement of those festivals, knowledge of which reached the Greeks from all directions by land and sea, they were, it seems, for a long time completely secure and protected through the figure of Apollo, drawn up here in all his pride. Apollo could counter by holding up the head of Medusa, for no power was more dangerous than this massive and grotesque Dionysian force.(20) Doric art has immortalized that majestic bearing of Apollo as he stands in opposition.(21) This resistance became more questionable and even impossible as similar impulses finally broke out from the deepest roots of Hellenic culture itself: now the effect of the Delphic god, in a timely final process of reconciliation, limited itself to taking the destructive weapon out of the hand of the powerful opponent. This reconciliation is the most important moment in the history of Greek culture. Wherever we look, the revolutionary effects of this event manifest themselves. It was the reconciliation of two opponents, who from now on observed their differences with a sharp demarcation of the border line to be kept between them and with occasional gifts sent to honour each other, but basically the gap was not bridged over. However, if we see how, under the pressure of that peace agreement, the Dionysian power revealed itself, then we now understand the meaning of the festivals of world redemption and days of transfiguration in the Dionysian orgies of the Greeks, in comparison with that Babylonian Sacaea, which turned human beings back into tigers and apes. In these Greek festivals, for the first time nature achieves its artistic jubilee. In them, for the first time, the tearing apart of the principii individuationis [the principle of individuation] becomes an artistic phenomenon. Here that dreadful witches’ cauldron of lust and cruelty was without power. The strange mixture and ambiguity in the emotions of the Dionysian celebrant only remind him—as healing potions remind one of deadly poison—of that phenomenon that pain awakens joy and that the jubilation in his chest rips out cries of agony. From the most sublime joy echoes the cry of horror or the

longingly plaintive lament over an irreparable loss. In those Greek festivals it was as if a sentimental feature of nature is breaking out, as if nature has to sigh over her dismemberment into separate individuals. The song and the language of gestures of such a doubly defined celebrant was for the Homeric Greek world something new and unheard of, and in it Dionysian music, in particular, awoke fear and terror. If music was apparently already known as an Apollonian art, this music, strictly speaking, was a rhythmic pattern like the sound of waves, whose artistic power had been developed for presenting Apollonian states. The music of Apollo was Doric architecture expressed in sound, but only in intimate tones characteristic of the cithara.(22) It kept at a careful distance, as something un-Apollonian, the particular element which constitutes the character of Dionysian music and, along with that, of music generally, the emotionally disturbing tonal power, the unified stream of melody, and the totally incomparable world of harmony. In the Dionysian dithyramb man is aroused to the highest intensity of all his symbolic capabilities; something never felt forces itself into expression, the destruction of the veil of Maja, the sense of oneness as the presiding genius of form, in fact, of nature itself. Now the essence of nature is to express itself symbolically; a new world of symbols is necessary, the entire symbolism of the body, not just the symbolism of the mouth, of the face, and of the words, but the full gestures of the dance, all the limbs moving to the rhythm. And then the other symbolic powers grow, those of the music, in rhythm, dynamics, and harmony—with sudden violence. To grasp this total unleashing of all symbolic powers, man must already have attained that high level of freedom from the self which desires to express itself symbolically in those forces. Because of this, the dithyrambic servant of Dionysus will be understood only by someone like himself! With what astonishment must the Apollonian Greek have gazed at him! With an amazement which was all the greater as he sensed with horror that all this might not be really so foreign to him, that, in fact, his Apollonian consciousness was, like a veil, merely covering the Dionysian world in front of him. 3 In order to grasp this point, we must dismantle that artistic structure of Apollonian culture, as it were, stone by stone, until we see the foundations on which it is built. Here we now become aware for the first time of the marvellous Olympian divine forms, which stand on the pediments of this building and whose actions decorate its friezes all around in illuminating bas relief. If Apollo also stands among them as a single god next to others and without any claim to a pre-eminent position, we should not on that account let ourselves be deceived. The same drive which made itself sensuously perceptible in Apollo gave birth to that entire Olympian world in general, and, in this sense, we are entitled to value Apollo as the father of that world. What was the immense need out of which such an illuminating society of Olympian beings arose? Anyone who steps up to these Olympians with another religion in his heart and now seeks from them ethical loftiness, even sanctity,

non-physical spirituality, loving gazes filled with pity, will soon have to turn his back despondently in disappointment with them. Here there is no reminder of asceticism, spirituality, and duty: here speaks to us only a full, indeed a triumphant, existence, in which everything present is worshipped, no matter whether it is good or evil. And thus the onlooker may well stand in real consternation in front of this fantastic excess of life, to ask himself with what magical drink in their bodies these high-spirited men could have enjoyed life, so that wherever they look, Helen laughs back at them, that ideal image of their own existence, “hovering in sweet sensuousness.” However, we must call out to this onlooker who has already turned his back: “Don’t leave them. First listen to what Greek folk wisdom expresses about this very life which spreads itself out here before you with such inexplicable serenity. There is an old legend that king Midas for a long time hunted the wise Silenus, the companion of Dionysus, in the forests, without catching him. When Silenus finally fell into the king’s hands, the king asked what was the best thing of all for men, the very finest. The daemon remained silent, motionless and inflexible, until, compelled by the king, he finally broke out into shrill laughter and said these words, “Suffering creature, born for a day, child of accident and toil, why are you forcing me to say what would give you the greatest pleasure not to hear? The very best thing for you is totally unreachable: not to have been born, not to exist, to be nothing. The second best thing for you, however, is this—to die soon.” What is the relationship between the Olympian world of the gods and this popular wisdom? It is like the relationship of the entrancing vision of the tortured martyr to his torments. Now, as it were, the Olympic magic mountain reveals itself and shows us its roots. The Greek knew and felt the terror and horrors of existence: in order to be able to live at all, he must have placed in front of him the gleaming dream birth of the Olympians. That immense distrust of the titanic forces of nature, that Moira [Fate]enthroned mercilessly above everything which could be known, that vulture of the great friend of man, Prometheus, that fatal lot of wise Oedipus, that family curse on the House of Atreus, which compelled Orestes to kill his mother, in short, that entire philosophy of the woodland god, together with its mythical illustrations, from which the melancholy Etruscans died off—that was overcome time after time by the Greeks, or at least hidden and removed from view, through the artistic middle world [Mittelwelt]of the Olympians.(23) In order to be able to live, the Greeks must have created these gods out of the deepest necessity. We can readily imagine the sequential development of these gods: through that Apollonian drive for beauty there developed, by a slow transition out of the primordial titanic divine order of terror, the Olympian divine order of joy, just as roses break forth out of thorny bushes. How else could a people so emotionally sensitive, so spontaneously desiring, so singularly capable of suffering, have been able to endure their existence, unless the same qualities, with a loftier glory

flowing round them, manifested themselves in their gods. The same impulse which summons art into life as the seductive replenishment for further living and the completion of existence also gave rise to the Olympian world, in which the Hellenic "Will" held before itself a transfiguring mirror. In this way, the gods justify the lives of men, because they themselves live it—that is the only satisfactory theodicy! Existence under the bright sunshine of such gods is experienced as worth striving for in itself, and the essential pain of the Homeric men refers to separation from that sunlight, above all to the fact that such separation is coming soon, so that people could now say of them, with a reversal of the wisdom of Silenus, "The very worst thing for them was to die soon; the second worst was to die at all." When the laments resound now, they tell once more of short-lived Achilles, of the changes in the race of men, transformed like leaves, of the destruction of the heroic age. It is not unworthy of the greatest hero to long to live on, even as a day labourer.(24) Thus, in the Apollonian stage, the "Will" spontaneously demands to keep on living, the Homeric man feels himself so at one with living that even his lament becomes a song of praise. Here we must now point out that this harmony, looked on with such longing by more recent men, in fact, that unity of man with nature, for which Schiller coined the artistic slogan "naïve," is in no way such a simple, inevitable, and, as it were, unavoidable condition, like a human paradise, which we necessarily run into at the door of every culture: such a belief is possible only in an age which seeks to believe that Rousseau's Emile is also an artist and which imagines it has found in Homer an artist like Emile raised in the bosom of nature.(25) Wherever we encounter the "naïve" in art, we have to recognize the highest effect of Apollonian culture, which always first has to overthrow the kingdom of the Titans and to kill monsters and, through powerfully deluding images and joyful illusions, has to emerge victorious over the horrific depth of what we observe in the world and the most sensitive capacity for suffering. But how seldom does the naïve, that sense of being completely swallowed up in the beauty of appearance, succeed! For that reason, how inexpressibly noble is Homer, who, as a single individual, was related to that Apollonian popular culture as the individual dream artist is to the people's capacity to dream and to nature in general. Homeric "naïveté" is only to be understood as the complete victory of the Apollonian illusion. It is the sort of illusion which nature uses so frequently in order to attain her objectives. The true goal is concealed by a deluding image: we stretch our hands out toward this image, and nature reaches its goal through our deception. With the Greeks the "Will" wished to gaze upon itself through the transforming power of genius and the world of art; in order to glorify itself, its creatures had to sense that they themselves were worthy of being glorified; they had to see themselves again in a higher sphere, without this complete world of contemplation affecting them as an imperative or as a reproach. This is the

sphere of beauty, in which they saw their mirror images, the Olympians. With this mirror of beauty, the Hellenic “Will” fought against the talent for suffering, which is bound up with artistic talent, and the wisdom of suffering, and, as a memorial of its victory, Homer stands before us, the naive artist. 4 Using the analogy of a dream, we can learn something about this naive artist. If we recall how the dreamer, in the middle of his illusory dream world, calls out to himself, without destroying that world, “It is a dream. I want to continue dreaming it,” and if we can infer from that, on the one hand, that he has a deep inner delight at the contemplation of the dream, and, on the other, that he must have completely forgotten the day and its terrible demands, in order to be capable of dreaming at all with this inner joy at contemplation, then we may interpret all these phenomena, with the guidance of Apollo, the interpreter of dreams, in something like the manner which follows. To be sure, with respect to both halves of life, the waking and the dreaming parts, the first one strikes us as disproportionately more privileged, more important, more valuable, more worth living, in fact, the only part which is lived; nevertheless, I would like to assert, something of a paradox to all appearances, for the sake of that secret foundation of our essence, whose manifestation we are, precisely the opposite evaluation of dreams. For the more I become aware of those all-powerful natural artistic impulses and the fervent yearning for illusion contained in them, the desire to be redeemed through appearances, the more I feel myself pushed to the metaphysical assumption that the true being and the primordial oneness, ever-suffering and entirely contradictory, constantly uses the delightful vision, the joyful illusion, to redeem itself; we are compelled to experience this illusion, totally caught up in it and constituted by it, as the truly non-existent, that is, as a continuous development in time, space, and causality, in other words, as empirical reality. But if we momentarily look away from our own “reality,” if we grasp our empirical existence and the world in general as an idea of the primordial oneness created in every moment, then we must now consider our dream as the illusion of an illusion, as well as an even higher fulfillment of the original hunger for illusion. For this same reason, the innermost core of nature takes that indescribable joy in the naive artist and naive work of art, which is, in the same way, only “an illusion of an illusion.” Raphael, himself one of those immortal “naive” men, has presented in an allegorical painting that reduction of an illusion into an illusion, the fundamental process of the naive artist and Apollonian culture as well. (26) In his Transfiguration the bottom half shows us, with the possessed boy, the despairing porters, the helplessly frightened disciples, the mirror image of the eternal primordial pain, the sole basis of the world. The “illusion” here is the reflection of the eternal contradiction, of the father of things. Now, out of this illusion there rises up, like an ambrosial fragrance, a new world of illusion, like a vision, invisible to those trapped in the first scene—something illuminating and

hovering in the purest painless ecstasy, a shining vision to contemplate with eyes wide open. Here we have before our eyes, in the highest symbolism of art, that Apollonian world of beauty and its foundation, the frightening wisdom of Silenus, and we understand, through intuition, their reciprocal necessity. But Apollo confronts us once again as the divine manifestation of the principii individuationis, the only thing through which the eternally attained goal of the primordial oneness, its redemption through illusion, takes place: he shows us, with awe-inspiring gestures, how the entire world of torment is necessary, so that through it the individual is pushed to the creation of the redemptive vision and then, absorbed in contemplation of that vision, sits quietly in his rowboat, tossing around in the middle of the ocean. This deification of individuation, if it is thought of in general as commanding and proscriptive, understands only one law, the individual, that is, observing the limits of individualization, moderation in the Greek sense. Apollo, as an ethical divinity, demands moderation from his followers and, so that they can observe self-control, a knowledge of the self. And so alongside the aesthetic necessity of beauty run the demands “Know thyself” and “Nothing too much!”; whereas, arrogance and excess are considered the essentially hostile daemons belonging to the non-Apollonian sphere, and therefore characteristics of the pre-Apollonian period, the age of the Titans, and of the world beyond the Apollonian, that is, the barbarian world.(27) Because of his Titanic love for mankind, Prometheus had to be ripped apart by the vulture. For the sake of his excessive wisdom, which solved the riddle of the sphinx, Oedipus had to be overthrown in a bewildering whirlpool of evil. That is how the Delphic god interpreted the Greek past.(28) To the Apollonian Greek the effect aroused by the Dionysian also seemed “Titanic” and “barbaric.” But he could not, with that response, conceal that he himself was, nonetheless, at the same time also internally related to those deposed Titans and heroes. Indeed, he must have felt even more: his entire existence, with all its beauty and moderation, rested on a hidden underground of suffering and knowledge, which was exposed for him again through that very Dionysian. And look! Apollo could not live without Dionysus! The “Titanic” and the “barbaric” were, in the end, every bit as necessary as the Apollonian! And now let us imagine how in this world, constructed on illusion and moderation and restrained by art, the ecstatic sound of the Dionysian celebration rang out all around with a constantly more enticing magic, how in these celebrations the entire excess of nature made itself known in joy, suffering, and knowledge, even in the most piercing scream. Let us imagine what the psalm-chanting Apollonian artist, with his ghostly harp music could have meant in comparison to this daemonic popular singing! The muses of the art of “illusion” withered away in the face of an art which spoke truth in its intoxicated state: the wisdom of Silenus cried out “Woe! Woe!” against the serene Olympians. The individual, with all his limits and moderation, was

destroyed in the self-oblivion of the Dionysian condition and forgot the Apollonian principles. Excess revealed itself as the truth. The contradiction, the ecstasy born from pain, spoke of itself right out of the heart of nature. And so the Apollonian was cancelled and destroyed everywhere the Dionysian penetrated. But it is just as certain that in those places where the first onslaught was halted, the high reputation and the majesty of the Delphic god manifested itself more firmly and threateningly than ever. For I can explain the Doric state and Doric art only as a constant Apollonian war camp: only through an uninterrupted opposition to the Titanic-barbaric essence of the Dionysian could such a defiantly aloof art, protected on all sides with fortifications, such a harsh upbringing as a preparation for war, and such a cruel and ruthless basis for government endure for a long time.(29) Up to this point I have set out at some length what I observed at the opening of this essay: how the Dionysian and the Apollonian ruled the Hellenic world in a constantly new sequence of births, one after the other, mutually intensifying each other; how, out of the “first” age, with its battles against the Titans and its austere popular philosophy, the Homeric world developed under the rule of the Apollonian drive for beauty; how this “naïve” magnificence was swallowed up once more by the breaking out of the Dionysian torrent; and how, in opposition to this new power, the Apollonian erected the rigid majesty of Doric art and the Doric world view. If in this way the earlier history of the Greeks, in the struggle of those two hostile principles, falls into four major artistic periods, we are now impelled to ask more about the final stage of this development and striving, in case we should consider, for example, the last attained period, the one of Doric art, the summit and intention of those artistic impulses. Here, the lofty and highly praised artistic achievement of Attic tragedy and of the dramatic dithyramb presents itself before our eyes, as the common goal of both impulses, whose secret marriage partnership, after a long antecedent struggle, glorified itself with such a child—at once Antigone and Cassandra.(30) 5 We are now approaching the essential goal of our undertaking, which aims at a knowledge of the Dionysian-Apollonian genius and its work of art, at least at an intuitive understanding of that mysterious unity. Here now, to begin with, we raise the question of where that new seed first manifests itself in the Hellenic world, the seed which later develops into tragedy and the dramatic dithyramb. On this question, classical antiquity itself gives us illustrative evidence when it places Homer and Archilochus next to each other in paintings, cameos, and so on, as the originators and torchbearers of Greek poetry, in full confidence that only these two should be equally considered completely original natures from whom a firestorm flowed out over the entire later world of the Greeks.(31) Homer, the ancient, self-absorbed dreamer, the archetype of the naïve Apollonian artist, now stares astonished at the passionate head of wild Archilochus, the fighting servant of the Muses, battered by existence. In its

interpretative efforts, our more recent aesthetics has known only how to indicate that here the first “subjective” artist stands in contrast to the “objective” artist. This interpretation is of little use to us, since we recognize the subjective artist only as a bad artist and demand in every style of art and every high artistic achievement, first and foremost, a victory over the subjective, redemption from the “I,” and the silence of every individual will and desire; indeed, we are incapable of believing the slightest artistic creation true, unless it has objectivity and a purely disinterested contemplation. Hence, our aesthetic must first solve that problem of how it is possible for the “lyric poet” to be an artist, for he, according to the experience of all ages, always says “I” and sings out in front of us the entire chromatic sequence of the sounds of his passions and desires. This very Archilochus startles us, alongside Homer, through the cry of his hate and scorn, through the drunken eruptions of his desire. By doing this, is not Archilochus, the first artist called subjective, essentially a non-artist? But then where does that veneration come from, which the Delphic oracle itself, the centre of “objective” art, showed to him, the poet, in very remarkable utterances. Schiller has illuminated his own writing process for us with a psychological observation which was inexplicable to him but which nevertheless did not appear questionable, for he confesses that when he was in a state of preparation, before he actually started writing, he did not have something like a series of pictures, with a structured causality of ideas, in front of him and inside him, but rather a musical mood (“With me, feeling at first lacks a defined and clear object; the latter develops for the first time later on. A certain musical emotional state comes first, and from this, with me, the poetic idea then follows.” If we now add the most important phenomenon of the entire ancient lyric, the union, universally acknowledged as natural, between the lyricist and the musician, in fact, their common identity—in comparison with which our recent lyrics look like the image of a god without a head—then we can, on the basis of the aesthetic metaphysics we established earlier, now account for the lyric poet in the following manner. He has, first of all, as a Dionysian artist, become entirely unified with the primordial oneness, with its pain and contradiction, and produces the reflection of this primordial oneness as music, if music can with justice be called a re-working of the world and its second casting. But now this music becomes perceptible to him once again, as in a metaphorical dream image, under the influence of Apollonian dreaming. That reflection, which lacks imagery and ideas, of the original pain in the music, together with its redemption in illusion, gives rise now to a second reflection as a particular metaphor or illustration. The artist has already surrendered his subjectivity in the Dionysian process; the image which now reveals to him his unity with the heart of the world is a dream scene, which symbolizes that original contradiction and pain, together with the primordial joy in illusion. The “I” of the lyric poet thus echoes out of the

abyss of being. What recent aestheticians mean by his “subjectivity” is mere fantasy. When Archilochus, the first Greek lyric poet, announces his raging love and, simultaneously, his contempt for the daughters of Lycambes, it is not his own passion which dances in front of us in an orgiastic frenzy: we see Dionysus and the maenads; we see the intoxicated reveler Archilochus sunk down in sleep—as Euripides describes it for us in the *Bacchae*, asleep in a high Alpine meadow in the midday sun—and now Apollo steps up to him and touches him with his laurel. The Dionysian musical enchantment of the sleeper now, as it were, flashes around him fiery images, lyrical poems, which are called, in their highest form, tragedies and dramatic dithyrambs. The plastic artist, as well as his relation, the epic poet, is absorbed in the pure contemplation of images. The Dionysian musician totally lacks every image and is in himself only and entirely the original pain and original reverberation of that image. The lyrical genius feels a world of images and metaphors grow up out of the mysterious state of unity and of renunciation of the self. These have a colour, causality, and speed entirely different from that world of the plastic artist and of the writer of epic. While the last of these (the epic poet) lives in these pictures and only in them with joyful contentment and does not get tired of contemplating them with love, right down to the smallest details, and while even the image of the angry Achilles is for him only a picture whose expression of anger he enjoys with that dream joy in illusions—so that he, by this mirror of appearances, is protected against the development of that sense of unity and of being fused together with the forms he has created—the images of the lyric poet are, by contrast nothing but he himself and, as it were, only different objectifications of himself. He can say “I” because he is the moving central point of that world; only this “I” is not the same as the “I” of the awake, empirically real man, but the single “I” of true and eternal being in general, the “I” resting on the foundation of things, through the portrayal of which the lyrical genius looks right into that very basis of things. Now, let’s imagine next how he also looks upon himself among these likenesses, as a non-genius, that is, as his own “Subject,” the entire unruly crowd of subjective passions and striving of his will aiming at something particular, which seems real to him. If it now appears as if the lyrical genius and the non-genius bound up with him were one and the same and as if the first of these spoke that little word “I” about himself, then this illusion could now no longer deceive us, not at least in the way it deceived those who have defined the lyricist as a subjective poet. To tell the truth, Archilochus, the man of passionately burning love and hate, is only a vision of the genius who is by this time no longer Archilochus but a world genius and who expresses his primordial pain symbolically in Archilochus as a metaphor for man; whereas, that subjectively willing and desiring man Archilochus can generally never ever be a poet. It is not at all essential that the lyric poet see directly in front of him only the phenomenon of the man

Archilochus as a reflection of eternal being, and tragedy shows how far the visionary world of the lyric poet can distance itself from that phenomenon clearly standing near at hand. Schopenhauer, who did not hide from the difficulty which the lyric poet creates for the philosophical observation of art, believed that he had discovered a solution, something which I cannot go along with, when in his profound metaphysics of music he alone found a way of setting that difficulty decisively to one side, as I believe I have done here, in his spirit and with due honour to him. For the sake of comparison, here is how he describes the essential nature of song: "The consciousness of the singer is filled with the subject of willing, that is, his own willing, often as an unleashed satisfied willing (joy), but also, and more often, as a restricted willing (sorrow), always as emotion, passion, a turbulent state of feeling. However, alongside this condition and simultaneous with it, the singer, through a glimpse at the surrounding nature, becomes aware of himself as a subject of pure, will-less knowledge, whose imperturbable, blessed tranquilly now enters in contrast to the pressure of his always hindered, always still limited willing: the sensation of this contrast, this game back and forth, is basically what expresses itself in the totality of the song and what, in general, creates the lyrical state. In this condition, pure understanding, as it were, comes to us, to save us from willing and the pressure of willing; we follow along, but only moment by moment: the will, the memory of our personal goals, constantly removes this calm contemplation from us, but over and over again the next beautiful setting, in which pure will-less knowledge presents itself to us once again, entices us away from willing. Hence, in the song and the lyrical mood, willing (the personal interest in purposes) and pure contemplation of the setting which reveals itself are miraculously mixed up together: we seek and imagine relationships between them both; the subjective mood, the emotional state of the will, communicates with the surroundings we contemplate, and the latter, in turn, give their colour to our mood, in a reflex action. The true song is the expression of this entire emotional condition, mixed and divided in this way" (World as Will and Idea, I.3.51). Who can fail to recognize in this description that here the lyric has been characterized as an incompletely realized art, a leap, as it were, which seldom attains its goal, indeed, as a semi-art, whose essence is to consist of the fact that the will and pure contemplation, that is, the unaesthetic and the aesthetic conditions, must be miraculously mixed up together? In contrast to this, we maintain that the entire opposition of the subjective and the objective, which even Schopenhauer still uses as a measurement of value to classify art, has generally no place in aesthetics, since the subject, the willing individual demanding his own egotistical purposes, can only be thought of as an enemy of art, not as its origin. But insofar as the subject is an artist, he is already released from his individual willing and has become, so to speak, a medium, through which a subject of true being celebrates its

redemption in illusion. For we need to be clear on this point, above everything else, to our humiliation and ennoblement: the entire comedy of art does not present itself for us in order to make us, for example, better or to educate us, even less because we are the actual creators of that art world. We are, however, entitled to assume this about ourselves: for the true creator of that world we are already pictures and artistic projections and in the meaning of works of art we have our highest dignity—for only as an aesthetic phenomenon are existence and the world eternally justified—while, of course, our consciousness of our own significance is scarcely any different from the consciousness which soldiers painted on canvas have of the battle portrayed there. Hence our entire knowledge of art is basically completely illusory, because, as knowing people, we are not one with and identical to that being who, as the single creator and spectator of that comedy of art, prepares for itself an eternal enjoyment. Only to the extent that the genius in the act of artistic creation is fused with that primordial artist of the world does he know anything about the eternal nature of art, for in that state he is, in a miraculous way, like the weird picture of fairy tales, which can turn its eyes and contemplate itself. Now he is simultaneously subject and object, simultaneously poet, actor, and spectator. 6 With respect to Archilochus, learned scholarship has revealed that he introduced the folk song into literature and that, because of this achievement, he earned that individual place next to Homer in the universal estimation of the Greeks. But what is the folk song in comparison to the completely Apollonian epic poem? What else but the *perpetuum vestigum* [the eternal mark] of a union between the Apollonian and the Dionysian; its tremendous expansion, extending to all peoples and constantly increasing with new births, testifies to us how strong that artistic double drive of nature is, which leaves its trace behind in the folk song, just as, in an analogous manner, the orgiastic movements of a people leave their mark in its music. In fact, there must also have been historical evidence to show how every period richly productive of folk songs at the same time has been stirred in the most powerful manner by Dionysian currents, something which we have to recognize always as the foundation and precondition of folk song. But to begin with, we must view the folk song as the musical mirror of the world, as the primordial melody, which now seeks for a parallel dream image of itself and expresses this in poetry. The melody is thus the primary and universal fact, for which reason it can in itself undergo many objectifications, in several texts. It is also far more important and more essential in the naive evaluations of the people. Melody gives birth to poetry from itself, over and over again. That is what the strophic form of the folk song indicates to us. I always observed this phenomenon with astonishment, until I finally came up with this explanation. Whoever looks at a collection of folk songs, for example, *Des Knaben Wunderhorn* [The Boy's Magic Horn] with this theory in mind will find countless examples of how the continually fecund

melody emits fiery showers of images around itself. These images, with their bright colours, their sudden alteration, indeed, their wild momentum, reveal a power completely foreign to the epic illusion and its calm forward progress. From the point of view of epic this uneven and irregular world of images in the lyric is easy to condemn—something no doubt the solemn epic rhapsodists of the Apollonian celebrations did in the age of Terpander.⁽³²⁾ Thus, in the poetry of the folk song we see language most strongly pressured to imitate music. Hence, with Archilochus a new world of poetry begins, something which conflicts in the most profound and fundamental way with the Homeric world. Here we have demonstrated the one possible relationship between poetry and music, word, and tone: the word, the image, the idea look for an analogous expression in music and now experience the inherent power of music. In this sense we can distinguish two main streams in the history of the language of the Greek people, corresponding to language which imitates appearance and images or language which imitates the world of music. Now, let's think for a moment more deeply about the linguistic difference in colour, syntactic structure, and vocabulary between Homer and Pindar in order to grasp the significance of this contrast.⁽³³⁾ Indeed, in this way it will become crystal clear to us that between Homer and Pindar the orgiastic flute melodies of Olympus must have rung out, which even in the time of Aristotle, in the midst of a music infinitely more sophisticated, drove people into raptures of drunken enthusiasm and with their primordial effect certainly stimulated all the poetical forms of expression of contemporaries to imitate them. I recall here a well-known phenomenon of our own times, something which strikes our aestheticians as merely objectionable. Again and again we experience how a Beethoven symphony makes it necessary for the individual listener to talk in images, even if it is also true that the collection of different worlds of imagery created by a musical piece really looks fantastically confused, indeed, contradictory. In the art of those aestheticians the proper thing to do is to exercise their poor wits on such collections and yet to overlook the phenomenon which is really worth explaining. In fact, even when the tone poet has spoken in images about a composition, for example, when he describes a symphony as a pastoral and one movement as "A Scene by the Brook," another as "A Frolicking Gathering of Peasants," these expressions are similarly only metaphors, images born out of the music—and not some objective condition imitated by the music—ideas which cannot teach us anything at all about the Dionysian content of the music and which, in fact, have no exclusive value alongside other pictures. Now, we have only to transfer this process of unloading music into pictures to a youthful, linguistically creative crowd of people in order to sense how the strophic folk song arises and how the entire linguistic capability is stimulated by the new principle of imitating music. If we are thus entitled to consider the lyrical poem as the mimetic efflorescence of music in pictures and

ideas, then we can now ask the following question: “What does music look like in the mirror of imagery and ideas?” It appears as the will, taking that word in Schopenhauer’s sense, that is, as the opposite to the aesthetic, purely contemplative, will-less state. Here we must now differentiate as sharply as possible the idea of being from the idea of appearance: it is impossible for music, given its nature, to be the will, because if that were the case we would have to ban music entirely from the realm of art—for the will consists of what is inherently unaesthetic—but music appears as the will. For in order to express that appearance in images, the lyric poet needs all the excitements of passion, from the whispers of affection right up to the ravings of lunacy. Under the impulse to speak of music in Apollonian metaphors, he understands all nature and himself in nature only as eternal willing, desiring, yearning. However, insofar as he interprets music in images, he himself is resting in the still tranquillity of the sea of Apollonian observation, no matter how much everything which he contemplates through that medium of music is moving around him, pushing and driving. Indeed, if he looks at himself through that same medium, his own image reveals itself to him in a state of emotional dissatisfaction: his own willing, yearning, groaning, cheering are for him a metaphor with which he interprets the music for himself. This is the phenomenon of the lyric poet: as an Apollonian genius, he interprets the music through the image of the will, while he himself, fully released from the greed of the will, is a pure, untroubled eye of the sun. This entire discussion firmly maintains that the lyric is just as dependent on the spirit of music as is music itself. In its fully absolute power, music does not need image and idea, but only tolerates them as something additional to itself. The poetry of the lyricist can express nothing which was not already latent in the most immense universality and validity of the music, which forces him to speak in images. The world symbolism of music for this very reason cannot in any way be exhausted by or reduced to language, because music addresses itself symbolically to the primordial contradiction and pain in the heart of the original oneness, and thus presents in symbolic form a sphere which is above all appearances and prior to them. In comparison with music, each appearance is far more a mere metaphor: hence, language, as voice and symbol of appearances, can never ever convert the deepest core of music to something external, but always remains, as long as it involves itself with the imitation of music, only in superficial contact with the music. The full eloquence of lyric poetry cannot bring us one step closer to the deepest meaning of music. 7 We must now seek assistance from all the artistic principles laid out above, in order to find our way correctly through the labyrinth, a descriptive term we have to use to designate the origin of Greek tragedy. I do not think I am saying anything illogical when I claim that the problem of this origin still has not once been seriously formulated up to now, let alone solved, no matter how frequently the scattered scraps of

ancient tradition have already been combined with one another and then torn apart once more. This tradition tells us very emphatically that tragedy developed out of the tragic chorus and originally consisted only of a chorus and nothing else. This fact requires us to look into the heart of this tragic chorus as the essential original drama, without allowing ourselves to be satisfied at all with the common ways of talking about art—that the chorus is the ideal spectator or had the job of standing in for the people over against the royal area of the scene. That last mentioned point, a conceptual explanation which sounds so lofty for many politicians—as though the invariable moral law was presented by the democratic Athenians in the people’s chorus, which was always proved right in matters dealing with the kings’ passionate acts of violence and excess—may well have been suggested by a word from Aristotle. But such an idea has no influence on the original formation of tragedy, since all the opposition between people and ruler and every political-social issue in general is excluded from those purely religious origins. But looking back on the classical form of the chorus known to us in Aeschylus and Sophocles we might also consider it blasphemous to talk here of a premonition of a “constitutional popular representation.” Others have not been deterred from this blasphemous assertion. The ancient political organizations of the state had no knowledge in praxi [in practice] of a constitutional popular representation, and, in addition, they never once had a hopeful “premonition” of such things in their tragedies. Much more famous than this political explanation of the chorus is A. W. Schlegel’s idea.⁽³⁴⁾ He recommended that we consider the chorus to some extent as the quintessence and embodiment of the crowd of onlookers, as the “ideal spectator.” This view, combined with the historical tradition that originally the tragedy consisted entirely of the chorus, reveals itself for what it is, a crude and unscholarly, although dazzling, claim. But its glitter survives only in the compact form of the expression, from the truly German prejudice for everything which is called “ideal,” and from our momentary astonishment. For we are astonished, as soon as we compare the theatre public we know well with that chorus and ask ourselves whether it would be at all possible on the basis of this public ever to derive some idealization analogous to the tragic chorus. We tacitly deny this and are now surprised by the audacity of Schlegel’s claim, as well as by the totally different nature of the Greek general public. For we had always thought that the proper spectator, whoever he might be, must always remain conscious that he has a work of art in front of him, not an empirical reality; whereas, the tragic chorus of the Greeks is required to recognize the shapes on the stage as living, existing people. The chorus of Oceanids really believes that they see the Titan Prometheus in front of them and consider themselves every bit as real as the god of the scene. And was that supposed to be the highest and purest type of spectator, a person who, like the Oceanids, considers Prometheus vitally alive

and real? Would it be a mark of the ideal spectator to run up onto the stage and free the god from his torment? We had believed in an aesthetic public and considered the individual spectator all the more capable, the more he was in a position to take the work of art as art, that is, aesthetically, and now this saying of Schlegel's indicates to us that the completely ideal spectator lets the scenic world work on him, not aesthetically at all, but vitally and empirically. "O these Greeks!" we sigh, "they are knocking over our aesthetics!" But once we get familiar with the idea, we repeat Schlegel's saying every time we talk about the chorus. But that emphatic tradition speaks here against Schlegel: the chorus in itself, without the stage, that is, the primitive form of tragedy, and that chorus of ideal spectators are not compatible. What sort of artistic style would there be which one might derive from the idea of the spectator, for which one might consider the "spectator in himself" the essential form? The spectator without a play is a contradictory idea. We suspect that the birth of tragedy cannot be explained either from the high estimation of the moral intelligence of the masses or from the idea of the spectator without a play, and we consider this problem too profound even to be touched upon by such superficial styles of commentary. Schiller has already provided an infinitely more valuable insight into the meaning of the chorus in the famous preface to the *Bride from Messina*, which sees the chorus as a living wall which tragedy draws around itself in order to separate itself cleanly from the real world and to protect its ideal space and its poetical freedom for itself.⁽³⁵⁾ With this as his main weapon Schiller fought against the common idea of naturalism, against the common demand for illusion in dramatic poetry. While in the theatre the day itself might be only artistic and stage architecture only symbolic, and the metrical language might have an ideal quality, on the whole, a misconception still ruled: it was not enough, Schiller claimed, that people merely tolerated as poetic freedom what, by contrast, was the essence of all poetry. The introduction of the chorus was the decisive step with which war was declared openly and honourably against every naturalism in art. Such a way of looking at things is the one, it strikes me, for which our age, which considers itself so superior, uses the dismissive catch phrase "pseudo-idealism." But I rather suspect that with our present worship of naturalism and realism we are situated at the opposite pole from all idealism, namely, in the region of a wax works collection. In that, too, there is an art, as in certain popular romance novels of the present time. Only let no one pester us with the claim that the "pseudo-idealism" of Schiller and Goethe has been overcome with this art. Of course, it is an "ideal" stage on which, according to Schiller's correct insight, the Greek satyr chorus, the chorus of the primitive tragedy, customarily strolled, a stage lifted high over the real strolling stage of mortal men. For this chorus the Greeks constructed a suspended scaffolding of an imaginary state of nature and on it placed imaginary natural beings. Tragedy grew up out of this foundation

and, for that very reason, has, from its inception, been spared the embarrassing business of counterfeiting reality. That is not to say, however, that it is a world arbitrarily fantasized somewhere between heaven and earth. It is much rather a world possessing the same reality and credibility as the world of Olympus, together with its inhabitants, had for the devout Greek. The satyr, as the Dionysian chorus member, lives in a reality granted by religion and sanctioned by myth and ritual. The fact that tragedy begins with him, that out of him the Dionysian wisdom of tragedy speaks, is a phenomenon as foreign to us here as the development of tragedy out of the chorus generally. Perhaps we can reach a starting point for this discussion when I offer the claim that the satyr himself, the imaginary natural being, is related to the cultural person in the same way that Dionysian music is related to civilization. On this last point Richard Wagner states that civilization is neutralized by music in the same way light from a lamp is neutralized by daylight. In just such a manner, I believe, the cultured Greek felt himself neutralized by the sight of the chorus of satyrs, and the next effect of Dionysian tragedy is that the state and society, in general the gap between man and man, give way to an invincible feeling of unity, which leads back to the heart of nature. The metaphysical consolation with which, as I am immediately indicating here, every true tragedy leaves us, that, in spite of all the transformations in phenomena, at the bottom of everything life is indestructibly powerful and delightful, this consolation appears in lively clarity as the chorus of satyrs, as the chorus of natural beings, who live, so to speak, indestructibly behind all civilization, and who, in spite of all the changes in generations and a people's history, always remain the same. With this chorus, the profound Greek, uniquely capable of the most delicate and the most severe suffering, consoled himself, the man who looked around with a daring gaze in the middle of the terrifying destructive instincts of so-called world history and equally into the cruelty of nature and who is in danger of longing for a Buddhist denial of the will. Art saves him, and through art life saves him. The ecstasy of the Dionysian state, with its obliteration of the customary manacles and boundaries of existence, contains, of course, for as long as it lasts a lethargic element, in which everything personally experienced in the past is immersed. Because of this gulf of oblivion, the world of everyday reality and the world of Dionysian reality separate from each other. But as soon as that daily reality comes back again into consciousness, one feels it as something disgusting. The fruit of that state is an ascetic condition, in which one denies the power of the will. In this sense the Dionysian man has similarities to Hamlet: both have had a real glimpse into the essence of things. They have understood, and it disgusts them to act, for their action can change nothing in the eternal nature of things. They perceive as ridiculous or humiliating the fact that they are expected to set right again a world which is out of joint. The knowledge kills action, for action requires a state of

being in which we are covered with the veil of illusion—that is what Hamlet has to teach us, not that really venal wisdom about John-a-Dreams, who cannot move himself to act because of too much reflection, because of an excess of possibilities, so to speak. It's not a case of reflection. No!—the true knowledge, the glimpse into the cruel truth overcomes every driving motive to act, both in Hamlet as well as in the Dionysian man. Now no consolation has any effect any more. His longing goes out over a world, even beyond the gods themselves, toward death. Existence is denied, together with its blazing reflection in the gods or in an immortal afterlife. In the consciousness of once having glimpsed the truth, the man now sees everywhere only the horror or absurdity of being; now he understands the symbolism in the fate of Ophelia; now he recognizes the wisdom of the forest god Silenus. It disgusts him. Here, at a point when the will is in the highest danger, art approaches, as a saving, healing magician. Art alone can turn those thoughts of disgust at the horror or absurdity of existence into imaginary constructs which permit living to continue. These constructs are the Sublime as the artistic mastering of the horrible and the Comic as the artistic release from disgust at the absurd. The chorus of satyrs of the dithyramb is the saving fact of Greek art. Those emotional moods I have just described play themselves out in the middle world of these Dionysian attendants. 8 The satyr as well as the idyllic shepherd of our more recent times are both the epitomes of a longing directed toward the primordial and natural, but with what a firm, fearless grip the Greek held onto his man from the woods, and how timidly and weakly modern man toys with the flattering image of a delicate and gentle flute-playing shepherd! Nature on which no knowledge had yet worked, in which the walls of culture had still not been thrown up—that's what the Greek saw in his satyr, and so he did not yet mistake him for an ape. Quite the contrary: the satyr was the primordial image of man, the expression of his highest and strongest emotions, as an inspired reveller, enraptured by the approach of the god, as a sympathetic companion, in whom the suffering of the god was repeated, as a messenger bringing wisdom from the deepest heart of nature, as a perceptible image of the sexual omnipotence of nature, which the Greek was accustomed to observing with reverent astonishment. The satyr was something sublime and divine: that's how he must have seemed, especially to the painfully broken gaze of the Dionysian man, who would have been insulted by our well-groomed fictitious shepherd. His eye lingered with sublime satisfaction on the exposed, vigorous, and magnificent script of nature; here the illusion of culture was wiped away by the primordial image of man; here the real man revealed himself, the bearded satyr, who cried out with joy to his god. In comparison with him, the man of culture was reduced to a misleading caricature. Schiller was also right about the start of tragic art: the chorus is a living wall against the pounding reality, because it—the satyr chorus—presents existence more genuinely, more truly, and more

completely than does the civilized person, who generally considers himself the only reality. The sphere of poetry does not lie beyond this world as a fantastic impossibility of a poet's brain; it wants to be exactly the opposite, the unadorned expression of the truth, and it must therefore simply cast off the false costume of that alleged truth of the man of culture. The contrast between this real truth of nature and the cultural lie which behaves as if it is the only reality is similar to the contrast between the eternal core of things, the thing-in-itself, and the total world of appearances. And just as tragedy, with its metaphysical consolation, draws attention to the eternal life of that existential core in the continuing destruction of appearances, so the symbolism of the satyr chorus already expresses metaphorically that primordial relationship between the thing-in-itself and appearance. That idyllic shepherd of modern man is only a counterfeit, the totality of cultural illusions which he counts as nature. The Dionysian Greek wants truth and nature in their highest power—he sees himself magically changed into the satyr. The enraptured horde of those who served Dionysus rejoiced under such moods and insights, whose power transformed them even before their very eyes, so that they imagined they saw themselves as restored natural geniuses, as satyrs. The later constitution of the tragic chorus is the artistic imitation of that natural phenomenon, in which now a division was surely necessary between the Dionysian spectators and those under the Dionysian enchantment. But we must always remind ourselves that the public for Attic tragedy rediscovered itself in the chorus of the orchestra, that basically there was no opposition between the public and the chorus: for everything is only a huge sublime chorus of dancing and singing satyrs or of those people who permit themselves to be represented by these satyrs.(36) That saying of Schlegel's here must become accessible to us in a deeper sense. The chorus is the "ideal spectator," insofar as it is the single onlooker, the person who sees the visionary world of the scene. A public of spectators, as we are familiar with it, was unknown to the Greeks. In their theatre, given the way the spectators' space was built up in terraces of concentric rings, it was possible for everyone quite literally to look out over the collective cultural world around him and in that complete perspective to imagine himself a member of the chorus. Given this insight, we can call the chorus, in its primitive stages of the prototypical tragedy, the self-reflection of the Dionysian man, a phenomenon which we can make out most clearly in the experience of the actor, who, if he is really gifted, sees perceptibly in front of him the image of the role he has to play, hovering before his eyes, there for him to grasp. The satyr chorus is, first and foremost, a vision of the Dionysian mass, just as, in turn, the world of the stage area is a vision of this satyr chorus: the power of this vision is strong enough to dull and desensitize the impression of "reality," the sight of the cultured people ranged in their rows of seats all around. The form of the Greek theatre is a reminder of a solitary

mountain valley: the architecture of the scene appears as an illuminated picture of a cloud, which the Bacchae swarming around in the mountains gaze upon from on high, as the majestic setting in the middle of which the image of Dionysus is revealed to them.(37) This primitive artistic illusion, which we are putting into words here to explain the tragic chorus, is, from the perspective of our scholarly views about the basic artistic process, almost offensive, although nothing can be more obvious than that the poet is only a poet because of the fact that he sees himself surrounded by shapes which live and act in front of him and into whose innermost being he gazes. Through some peculiar weakness in our modern talent, we are inclined to imagine primitive aesthetic phenomena in too complicated and abstract a manner. For the true poet, metaphor is not a rhetorical trope, but a representative image which really hovers in front of him in the place of an idea. For him the character is not some totality put together from individual traits collected bit by bit, but a living person, insistently there before his eyes, which differs from the similar vision of the painter only through its continued further living and acting. Why does Homer give us descriptions so much more vivid than all the poets? Because he sees so much more around him. We speak about poetry so abstractly because we all tend to be poor poets. The aesthetic phenomenon is fundamentally simple: if someone simply possesses the capacity to see a living game going on continually and to live all the time surrounded by hordes of ghosts, then the man is a poet; if someone simply feels the urge to change himself and to speak out from other bodies and souls, then that person is a dramatist. Dionysian excitement is capable of communicating this artistic talent to an entire multitude, so that they see themselves surrounded by such a horde of ghosts with which they know they are inwardly one. This dynamic of the tragic chorus is the original dramatic phenomenon: to see oneself transformed before one's eyes and now to act as if one really had entered another body, another character. This process stands at the beginning of the development of drama. Here is something different from the rhapsodist, who does not fuse with his images, but, like the painter, sees them with an observing eye outside himself; in the dramatic process there is already a surrender of individuality by the entry into a strange nature. And, in fact, this phenomenon breaks out like an epidemic; an entire horde feels itself enchanted in this way. For this reason the dithyramb is essentially different from every other choral song. The virgins who move solemnly to Apollo's temple with laurel branches in their hands, singing a processional song as they go, remain who they are and retain their names as citizens. The dithyrambic chorus is a chorus of transformed people, for whom their civic past, their social position, is completely forgotten.(38) They have become their god's timeless servants, living beyond all regions of society. Every other choral lyric of the Greeks is only an immense intensification of the Apollonian solo singer; whereas, in the dithyramb a congregation of unconscious

actors stands before us, who look upon each other as transformed. Enchantment is the precondition for all dramatic art. In this enchantment the Dionysian reveller sees himself as a satyr, and then, in turn, as a satyr he looks at his god; that is, in his transformed state he sees a new vision outside himself as an Apollonian fulfillment of his condition. With this new vision drama is complete. Keeping this knowledge in mind, we must understand Greek tragedy as the Dionysian chorus which over and over again discharges itself in an Apollonian world of images. Those choral passages interspersed through tragedy are thus, as it were, the maternal womb of the entire dialogue so-called, that is, of the totality of the stage word, the actual drama. This primordial basis of tragedy radiates that vision of drama out in several discharges following one after the other, a vision which is entirely a dream image and, in this respect, epic in nature, but, on the other hand, as an objectification of a Dionysian state, it presents not the Apollonian consolation in illusion, but, by contrast, the smashing of individuality and becoming one with primordial being. Thus, drama is the Apollonian embodiment of Dionysian knowledge and effects, and, hence, is separated as if by an immense gulf from epic. This conception of ours provides a full explanation for the chorus of Greek tragedy, the symbol for the collectively aroused Dionysian multitude. While we, given what we are used to with the role of the chorus on the modern stage, especially the chorus in opera, have been totally unable to grasp how that tragic chorus of the Greeks could be older, more original, in fact, more important than the actual "action"—as tradition tells us so clearly—while we, in turn, could not figure out why, given that traditionally high importance and original pre-eminence, the chorus would nonetheless be put together only out of lowly serving creatures, in fact, at first only out of goat-like satyrs, and while for us the orchestra in front of the acting area remained a constant enigma, now we have come to the insight that the acting area, together with the action, was basically and originally thought of only as a vision, that the single "reality" is simply the chorus, which creates the vision out of itself and speaks of that with the entire symbolism of dance, tone, and word. This chorus in its vision gazes at its lord and master Dionysus and is thus always the chorus of servants; the chorus sees how Dionysus, the god, suffers and glorifies himself, and thus it does not itself act. But in this role, as complete servants in relation to the god, the chorus is nevertheless the highest, that is, the Dionysian expression of nature and, like nature, in its frenzy speaks the language of oracular wisdom. As the sympathetic as well as wise person, it announces the truth out of the heart of the world. So arises that fantastic and apparently so offensive figure of the wise and frenzied satyr, who is, at the same time, "the simple man" in contrast to the god: an image of nature and its strongest drives, indeed, a symbol of that and at the same time the announcer of its wisdom and art: musician, poet, dancer, visionary in a single person. According to this insight and to the tradition,

Dionysus, the actual stage hero and central point of the vision, was at first, in the very oldest periods of tragedy, not really present but was only imagined as present. That is, originally tragedy is only “chorus” and not “drama.” Later the attempt was made to show the god as real and then to present in a way visible to every eye the form of the vision together with the transfiguring setting. At that point “drama” in the strict sense begins. Now the dithyrambic chorus takes on the task of stimulating the mood of the listeners right up to the Dionysian level, so that when the tragic hero appears on the stage, they do not see something like an awkward masked person but a visionary shape born, as it were, out of their own enchantment. If we imagine Admetus thinking deeply about his recently departed wife Alcestis, completely pining away in his spiritual contemplation of her—how suddenly is led up to him an image of a woman of similar form and similar gait, but in disguise; if we imagine his sudden trembling agitation, his emotional comparisons, his instinctive conviction—then we have an analogy to the sensation with which the aroused Dionysian spectator saw striding onto the stage the god with whose suffering he has already become one.(39)

Spontaneously he transferred the whole picture of the god, magically trembling in front of his soul, onto that masked form and dissolved the reality of that figure, so to speak, in a ghostly unreality. This is the Apollonian dream state, in which the world of day veils itself and a new world, clearer, more comprehensible, more moving than the first, and yet more shadow-like, generates itself anew in a continuing series of changes before our eyes. With this in mind, we can recognize in tragedy a drastic contrast of styles: speech, colour, movement, dynamics of speech appear in the Dionysian lyric of the chorus and, on the other hand, in the Apollonian dream world of the scene as expressive spheres completely separate from each other. The Apollonian illusions, in which Dionysus objectifies himself, are no longer “an eternal sea, a changing weaving motion, a glowing life,” as is the case with the music of the chorus, no longer those powers which are only felt and cannot be turned into poetic images, moments when the frenzied servant of Dionysus feels the approach of the god. (40) Now, from the acting area the clarity and solemnity of the epic form speak to him; now Dionysus no longer speaks through forces but as an epic hero, almost with the language of Homer. 9 Everything which comes to the surface in the Apollonian part of Greek tragedy, in the dialogue, looks simple, translucent, beautiful. In this sense the dialogue is an image of the Greek man, whose nature reveals itself in dancing, because in dancing the greatest power is only latent, but it betrays its presence in the lithe and rich movement. Thus, the language of the heroes in Sophocles surprises us by its Apollonian clarity and brightness, so that we immediately imagine that we are glimpsing the innermost basis of their being, with some astonishment that the path to this foundation is so short. However, once we look away from the character of the hero as it surfaces and becomes

perceptible—a character who is basically nothing more than a light picture cast onto a dark wall, that is, an illusion through and through— we penetrate instead into the myth which projects itself in this bright reflection. At that point we suddenly experience a phenomenon which is the reverse of a well-known optical one. When we make a determined attempt to look directly at the sun and turn away blinded, we have dark-coloured specks in front of our eyes, like a remedy, as it were. Those illuminated illusory pictures of the Sophoclean hero, briefly put, the Apollonian mask, are the reverse of that, necessary creations of a glimpse into the inner terror of nature, bright spots, so to speak, to heal us from the horrifying night of the crippled gaze. Only in this sense can we think of correctly grasping the serious and significant idea of “Greek serenity”; whereas, nowadays we certainly come across the undoubtedly misconceived idea that this serenity is a condition of secure contentment on all the pathways and bridges of the present. The most painful figure of the Greek stage, the ill-fated Oedipus, is understood by Sophocles as the noble man who is destined for error and misery in spite of his wisdom, but who, through his immense suffering, at the end exerts a magically beneficial effect around him, which still has an effect beyond his death.⁽⁴¹⁾ The noble man does not sin—that’s what the profound poet wishes to tell us: through Oedipus’ actions every law, every natural principle of order, indeed, the moral world may collapse, but because of these very actions a higher magical circle of consequences is created, which founds a new world on the ruins of the old world, which has been overthrown. Insofar as the poet is also a religious thinker, that is what he wishes to say to us; as a poet, he shows us first a wonderfully complicated legal knot, which the judge slowly undoes, link by link, in the process destroying himself. The real joy for the Greek in this dialectical solution is so great that because of it a sense of powerful serenity invests the entire work, which always breaks the sting of the dreadful assumptions of that plot. In Oedipus in Colonus we run into this same serenity, but elevated in an immeasurable transfiguration. In contrast to the old man afflicted with excessive suffering, a man who is exposed purely as a man suffering from everything which happens to him—there stands the supernatural serenity which descends from the sphere of the gods and indicates to us that the hero in his purely passive conduct achieves his highest activity, which reaches out far over his own life; whereas, his conscious striving in his earlier life led him only to passivity. Thus, for the mortal eye the inextricably tangled legal knot of the Oedipus story is slowly untangled—and the most profound human joy suffuses us with this divine dialectical companion piece. If we have done justice to the poet with this explanation, one can still nonetheless ask whether the content of the myth has been exhausted in that explanation. And here we see that the entire conception of the poet is simply nothing other than that illuminated image which healing nature holds up before us after a glimpse into the abyss. Oedipus the murderer of his

father, the husband of his mother, Oedipus the solver of the riddle of the sphinx! What does the secret trinity of these fatal events tell us? There was a very ancient folk belief, especially in Persia, that a wise magus could be born only out of incest. Looking at Oedipus as the solver of riddles and the lover of his own mother, what we have to interpret immediately is the fact that right there where, through prophecy and magical powers, the spell of present and future is broken, that rigid law of individuation and the essential magic of nature in general, an immense natural horror—in this case incest—must have come first as the original cause. For how could we have compelled nature to yield up her secrets, if not for the fact that we fight back against her and win, that is, if not for the fact that we commit unnatural actions? I see this insight stamped out in that dreadful trinity of Oedipus's fate: the same man who solves the riddle of nature—of that ambiguous sphinx—must also break the most sacred natural laws when he murders his father and marries his mother. Indeed, the myth seems to want to whisper to us that wisdom, and especially Dionysian wisdom, is an unnatural atrocity, that a man who through his knowledge pushes nature into the abyss of destruction also has to experience in himself the disintegration of nature. "The spear point of knowledge turns itself against the wise man. Wisdom is a crime against nature." (42) The myth calls out such terrible statements to us, but, like a ray of sunlight, the Greek poet touches the awe-inspiring and fearful Memnon's Column of myth, so that it suddenly begins to play music—Sophoclean melodies. (43) Now I am going to compare the glory of passivity with the glory of activity which illuminates Aeschylus's Prometheus. What Aeschylus the thinker had to say to us here, but what Aeschylus as a poet could only hint to us through a metaphorical picture—that's something young Goethe knew how to reveal to us in the bold words of his Prometheus: "Here I sit—I make men in my own image, a race like me, to suffer, to weep, to enjoy life and rejoice, and to ignore you, as I do." (44) Man, rising up into something Titanic, is victorious over his own culture and compels the gods to unite with him, because in his autonomous wisdom he holds their existence and the limits to their authority in his hand. The most marvellous thing in that poem of Prometheus, which is, according to its basic ideas, essentially a hymn celebrating impiety, is, however, the deep Aeschylean impulse for justice: the immeasurable suffering of the brave "individual," on the one hand, and, on the other, the peril faced by the gods, in fact, a presentiment of a twilight of the gods, the compelling power for a metaphysical oneness, for a reconciliation of both these worlds of suffering—all this is a most powerful reminder of the central point and major claim of the Aeschylean world view, which sees Moira [Fate] enthroned over gods and men as eternal justice. In considering the astonishing daring with which Aeschylus places the Olympian world on his scales of justice, we must remind ourselves that the deep-thinking Greek had an unshakably firm basis for metaphysical

thinking in his mystery cults and that he could unload all his sceptical moods onto the Olympians. The Greek artist, in particular, with respect to these divinities, felt a dark sense of reciprocal dependency, and this sense is symbolized directly in Aeschylus's Prometheus. The Titanic artist discovered in himself the defiant belief that he could make men and, at the very least, destroy Olympian gods—and he could do this through his higher wisdom, which he, of course, was compelled to atone for with eternal suffering. The magnificent “capability” of the great genius, for whom eternal suffering itself is too cheap a price, the stern pride of the artist—that is the content and soul of Aeschylean poetry; whereas, Sophocles in his Oedipus sounds out the prelude to the victory song of the holy man. But also that meaning which Aeschylus gave the myth does not fully measure the astonishing depth of its terror. On the contrary, the artist's joy in being, the serenity of artistic creativity in spite of every impiety, is only a light picture of cloud and sky mirrored in a dark lake of sorrow. The Prometheus saga is a primordial possession of the Aryan population collectively and documentary evidence of their talent for the profoundly tragic. In fact, it could well be the case that for the Aryan being this myth has the same characteristic significance as the myth of the Fall does for the Semitic peoples and that both myths are related, like brother and sister. The pre-condition of that Prometheus myth is the extraordinary value which a naive humanity associates with fire as the true Palladium of every rising culture.⁽⁴⁵⁾ But the fact that man freely controls fire and does not receive it merely as a gift from heaven, as a blazing lightning flash or warming rays of the sun, appeared to those contemplative primitive men as an outrage, a crime against divine nature. And so right away the first philosophical problem posed an awkward insoluble contradiction between man and god and pushed it, like a boulder, right up to the door of every culture. The best and loftiest thing which mankind can be blessed with men acquire through a crime, and now they must accept the further consequences, namely, the entire flood of suffering and troubles with which the offended divine presences must afflict the nobly ambitious human race: an austere notion which, through the value which it gives to the crime, stands in a curious contrast to the Semitic myth of the Fall, in which curiosity, lying falsehoods, temptation, lust, in short, a series of predominantly female emotions was looked upon as the origin of evil. What distinguishes the Aryan conception is the lofty view of the active transgression as the essentially Promethean virtue. With this, at the same time the ethical basis of pessimistic tragedy is established, together with the justification of human evils, that is, both of human guilt and of the forfeit of suffering caused by that guilt. The impiety in the essence of things—that's what the thinking Aryan is not inclined to quibble away—the contradiction in the heart of the world reveals itself to him as the interpenetration of different worlds, for example, a divine and a human world, each of which is

right individually but which must, as one individual alongside another one, suffer for its individuality. With this heroic push of the individual into the universal, with this attempt to stride out over the limits of individuation and to wish to be oneself a world being, man suffers in himself the original contradiction hidden in things, that is, he violates the laws, and he suffers. Just as among the Aryans crime is seen as male and among the Semites sin is seen as female, so the original crime was also committed by a man, the original sin by a woman. In this connection, the chorus of witches [in Goethe's *Faust*] says: We're not so particular in what we say: Woman takes a thousand steps to get her way. But no matter how quickly she can hurry on, With just one leap the man will get it done. Anyone who understands that innermost core of the Prometheus saga, namely, the imperative requirement that the individual striving like a Titan has to fall into crime, must also sense at the same time the un-Apollonian quality of this pessimistic idea, for Apollo wants to make individual beings tranquil precisely because he establishes border lines between them and, with his demands for self-knowledge and moderation, always reminds them once again of the most sacred laws of the world. However, to prevent this Apollonian tendency from freezing form into Egyptian stiffness and frigidity and to make sure the movement of the entire lake does not die away through the attempt of the Apollonian to prescribe to the individual waves their path and their extent, from time to time the high flood of the Dionysian once again destroys all those small circles in which the one-sided Apollonian "will" seeks to confine the Greek spirit. Now that suddenly rising flood of the Dionysian takes the single small wave crest of the individual on its back, just as the brother of Prometheus, the Titan Atlas, shouldered the Earth. This Titanic impulse to become, as it were, the Atlas of all individuals and to bear them on one's wide back, higher and higher, further and further, is the common link between the Promethean and the Dionysian.(46) In this view, the Aeschylean Prometheus is a Dionysian mask, while, in that previously mentioned deep desire for Justice Aeschylus betrays, to the one who understands, his paternal descent from Apollo, the god of individuation and just boundaries. And so the double nature of the Aeschylean Prometheus, his simultaneously Dionysian and Apollonian nature, can be expressed in an understandable formula with the following words: "Everything present is just and unjust and equally justified in both." That is your world! That's what one calls a world!(47) 10 It is an incontestable tradition that Greek tragedy in its oldest form had as its subject only the suffering of Dionysus and that for a long time later the individually present stage heroes were simply Dionysus. But with the same certainty we can assert that right up to the time of Euripides Dionysus never ceased being the tragic hero, that all the famous figures of the Greek theatre, like Prometheus, Oedipus, and so on, are only masks of that primordial hero, Dionysus.(48) The fact that behind all these masks stands a divinity is the single fundamental reason

for the frequently admired characteristic “ideality” of those well-known figures. Someone, I don’t know who, made the claim that all individuals, as individuals, are comic and thus untragic, and from that we might gather that the Greeks in general could not tolerate individuals on the tragic stage.(49) In fact, they seem to have felt this way: that Platonic distinction between and evaluation of the “idea” in contrast to the “idol,” to copies, in general lies deeply grounded in the nature of the Greeks.(50) But for us to make use of Plato’s terminology, we would have to talk of the tragic figures of the Greek stage in something like the following terms: the one truly real Dionysus appears in a multiplicity of shapes, in the mask of a struggling hero and, as it were, bound up in the net of the individual will. So now the god made manifest talks and acts in such a way that he looks like an erring, striving, and suffering individual: the fact that he generally appears with this epic definition and clarity is the effect of Apollo, the interpreter of dreams, who indicates to the chorus its Dionysian state by that metaphorical appearance. In reality, however, that hero is the suffering Dionysus of the mysteries, that god who experiences the suffering of the individual in himself, the god about whom the amazing myths tell how he, as a child, was dismembered by the Titans and now in this condition is venerated as Zagreus. (51) Through this is revealed the idea that this dismemberment, the essentially Dionysian suffering, is like a transformation into air, water, earth, and fire, that we also have to look upon the condition of individuation as the source and basis for all suffering, as something in itself reprehensible. From the smile of this Dionysus arose the Olympian gods, from his tears arose mankind. In that existence as dismembered god Dionysus has the dual nature of a cruelly savage daemon and a lenient, gentle master. The initiates in the Eleusinian mysteries hoped for a rebirth of Dionysus, which we now can understand as a premonition of the end of individuation: the initiates’ thundering song of jubilation cried out to this approaching third Dionysus. And only with this hope was there a ray of joy on the face of the fragmented world, torn apart into individuals, as myth reveals in the picture of Demeter sunk in eternal sorrow, who rejoices again for the first time when someone says to her that she might be able once again to give birth to Dionysus. In these established views we already have assembled all the components of a profound and pessimistic world view, together with the mysterious doctrine of tragedy: the basic acknowledgement of the unity of all existing things, the observation that individuation is the ultimate foundation of all evil, art the joyful hope, that the spell of individuation is there for us to break, as a premonition of a re-established unity.— It has been pointed out earlier that the Homeric epic is the poetry of Olympian culture, with which it sang its own song of victory over the terrors of the fight against the Titans. Now, under the overwhelming influence of tragic poetry, the Homeric myths were newly reborn and show in this metamorphosis that since then the Olympian culture has also

been overcome by an even deeper world view. The defiant Titan Prometheus reported to his Olympian torturer that for the first time his rule was threatened by the highest danger, unless he quickly joined forces with him. In Aeschylus we acknowledge the union of the frightened Zeus, worried about his end, with the Titan. Thus the earlier age of the Titans is belatedly brought back from Tartarus into the light once more.⁽⁵²⁾ The philosophy of wild and naked nature looks with the open countenance of truth at the myths of the Homeric world dancing past it: before the flashing eyes of this goddess, those myths grow pale and tremble—until the mighty fist of the Dionysian artist forces them into the service of the new divinity. The Dionysian truth takes over the entire realm of myth as the symbol of its knowledge and speaks of this knowledge, partly in the public culture of tragedy and partly in the secret celebrations of dramatic mystery ceremonies, but always in the disguise of the old myths. What power was it which liberated Prometheus from his vultures and transformed the myth into a vehicle of Dionysian wisdom? It was the Herculean power of music, which attained its highest manifestation in tragedy and knew how to interpret myth with a new significance in the most profound manner, something we have already described before as the most powerful capacity of music. For it is the lot of every myth gradually to creep into the crevice of an assumed historical reality and to become analyzed as a unique fact in answer to the historical demands of some later time or other. The Greeks were already fully on their way to re-labeling cleverly and arbitrarily the completely mythical dreams of their youth as a historical, pragmatic, and youthful history. For this is the way religions tend to die out, namely, when the mythical pre-conditions of a religion, under the strict, rational eyes of an orthodox dogmatism, become systematized as a closed totality of historical events and people begin anxiously defending the credibility of their myths but resisting every naturally continuing life and further growth of those same myths and when the feeling for the myth dies out and in its place the claim to put religion on a historical footing steps forward. The newly born genius of Dionysian music now seized these dying myths, and in its hands myth blossomed again, with colours which it had never shown before, with a scent which stirred up a longing premonition of a metaphysical world. After this last flourishing, myth collapsed, its leaves grew pale, and soon the mocking Lucians of antiquity grabbed up the flowers, scattered around by all winds, colourless and withered. ⁽⁵³⁾ Through tragedy myth attains its most profound content, its most expressive form. It lifts itself up again, like a wounded hero, and all the remaining strength and wise tranquilly of a dying man burn in its eyes with its final powerful light. What did you want, you presumptuous Euripides, when you sought to force this dying man once more into your cheerful service? He died under your powerful hands. And now you used a counterfeit, masked myth, which knew only how to dress itself up with the old splendour, like Hercules' monkey. And as myth died

with you, so with you died the genius of music as well. Although you liked to plunder with greedy hands all the gardens of music, even so you achieved only a counterfeit, masked music. And because you abandoned Dionysus, you were then abandoned also by Apollo. Even though you hunted out all the passions from their beds and charmed them into your circle, even though you sharpened and filed a really sophisticated dialectic for the speeches of your heroes—nevertheless your heroes have only counterfeit, masked passions and speak only a counterfeit, masked dialogue. 11 Greek tragedy died in a manner different from all its ancient sister artistic styles: it died by suicide, as a result of an insoluble, hence tragic, conflict; whereas, all those others passed away in advanced old age with the most beautiful and most tranquil deaths. For if it is an appropriately happy natural condition to depart from life with beautiful descendants and without any painful strain, then the end of those older artistic genres manifests such a fortunate natural state of things. They disappeared slowly, and their more beautiful offspring were already standing there before their dying gazes, impatiently craning their heads with courageous gestures. By contrast, with the death of Greek tragedy there was created an immense emptiness, profoundly felt everywhere. Just as the Greek sailors at the time of Tiberius once heard from some isolated island the shattering cry “Great Pan is dead,” so now, like a painful lament, rang throughout the Greek world, “Tragedy is dead! Poetry itself is lost with it! Away, away with you, you stunted, emaciated epigones! Off with you to Hades, so that there you can for once eat your fill of the crumbs from your former masters!”(54) If now a new form of art still blossomed which paid tribute to tragedy as its predecessor and mistress, it was looked upon with fright, because while it certainly carried the characteristics of its mother, they were the ones she had shown in her long death struggle. This death struggle of tragedy was fought by Euripides, and that later art form is known as New Attic Comedy. In it the atrophied form of tragedy lived on, as a monument to tragedy’s extremely laborious and violent death. Looking at things this way, we can understand the passionate fondness the poets of the newer comedies felt for Euripides. Thus, Philemon’s desire to be hanged immediately merely so that he could seek out Euripides in the underworld, provided only he could be convinced that the dead man was still in possession of his wits, is no longer something strange. However, if we want to state, briefly and without claiming to say anything in detail, what Euripides has in common with Menander and with Philemon and what worked for them so excitingly and in such an exemplary manner in Euripides, it is enough to say that in Euripides the spectator is brought up onto the stage.(55) Anyone who has recognized the material out of which the Promethean tragedians before Euripides created their heroes and how remote from them lay any intention of bringing the true mask of reality onto the stage will also see clearly the totally deviant tendencies of Euripides. As a result of

Euripides, the man of ordinary life pushed his way out of the spectators' space and up onto the acting area. The mirror in which earlier only the great and bold features had been shown now displayed that awkward fidelity which also conscientiously reflected the unsuccessful features of nature. Odysseus, the typical Greek of the older art, now sank in the hands of the newer poets into the figure of Graeculus, who from now on stands right at the centre of dramatic interest as the good-hearted, clever house slave.(56) What Euripides in Aristophanes' *Frogs* gives himself credit for as a service, namely, that through his household medicines he freed tragic art of its pompous corpulence, that point we can trace above all in his tragic heroes. Essentially the spectator now saw and heard his double on the Euripidean stage and was happy that the character understood how to talk so well. But this was not the only delight. People themselves learned from Euripides how to speak. He praises himself on this very point in the contest with Aeschylus [in Aristophanes' *Frogs*]*—*how through him the people now learned to observe in an artistic way, with the keenest sophistication, to negotiate, and to draw conclusions. Because of this transformation in public language, he also made the new comedy generally possible. For from that time on there was nothing mysterious any more about how ordinary life could appear on stage and what stock phrases [Sentenzen] it would use. Middle-class mediocrity, on which Euripides built all his political hopes, now had its say. Up to that point, in tragedy the demi-god and in comedy the intoxicated satyr or semi-human had determined the nature of the language. And so the Aristophanic Euripides [in *Frogs*] gave himself high praise for how he presented common, well-known, ordinary living and striving, which any person was capable of judging. If now the entire crowd philosophized, administered their lands and goods with tremendous astuteness, and carried on their own legal matters, well then, he claimed, that was to his credit and the achievement of the wisdom which he had drummed into the people. The new comedy could now direct its attention to such a prepared and enlightened crowd, for whom Euripides became, to a certain extent, the choir master. Only this time the chorus of spectators had to have practice. As soon as this chorus was well trained to sing in the Euripidean musical key, that style of drama like a chess game arose, the New Comedy, with its continuing triumph of shrewdness and cunning. But Euripides, the leader of the chorus, was incessantly praised. Indeed, people would have let themselves be killed in order to learn even more from him, if they had not been aware that tragic poets were just as dead as tragedy itself. With tragedy, however, the Greeks had surrendered their faith in immortality, not merely the faith in an ideal past, but also the faith in an ideal future. The saying from the well-known written epitaph, "as an old man negligent and trivial" is applicable also to the old age of Hellenism. The instantaneous, the witty, the foolish, the capricious*—*these are its loftiest divinities; the fifth state, that of the slave, or at least the feelings of

a slave, now come to rule, and if in general one is entitled still to talk of a “Greek serenity,” it is the serenity of the slave, who has no idea how to take responsibility for anything difficult, how to strive for anything great, how to value anything in the past or future higher than the present. It was this appearance of “Greek serenity” which so outraged the profound and fearful natures of the first four centuries of Christianity; to them this feminine flight from seriousness and terror, this cowardly self-satisfaction with comfortable consumption, seemed not only despicable but also the essentially anti-Christian frame of mind. And to their influence we can ascribe the fact that the view of Greek antiquity as that age of pale rose-coloured serenity lasted for centuries and endured with almost invincible tenacity—as if Greek antiquity had never produced a sixth century, with its birth of tragedy, its mystery cults, its Pythagoras and Heraclitus, indeed, as if the artistic works of the great age simply did not exist—although these works, each and every one of them, cannot be explained at all on the grounds of such a senile joy in existence and serenity, a mood appropriate to a slave, these works which testify to a completely different world view as the basis of their existence.(57) Finally, when it is asserted that Euripides brought the spectator onto the stage in order to make the spectator truly capable for the first time of judging drama, it may appear as if the older tragic art had not resolved its false relationship to the spectator, and people might be tempted to value the radical tendency of Euripides to attain an appropriate relationship between the art work and the public as a progressive step beyond Sophocles. However, the “public” is only a word and not at all a constant, inherently firm value. Why should an artist be duty-bound to accommodate himself to a power whose strength is only in numbers? And if, with respect to his talent and intentions, the artist senses that he is superior to every single one of these spectators, how could he feel more respect for the common expression of all these capacities inferior to his own than for the one who was, by comparison, the most highly talented individual spectator? To tell the truth, no Greek artist handled his public over a long lifetime with greater daring and self-satisfaction than Euripides. As the masses hurled themselves at his feet, he himself sublimely defied even his own characteristic tendencies and openly slapped them in the face, those same tendencies with which he had conquered the masses. If this genius had had the slightest reverence for the pandemonium of the public, he would have broken apart under the cudgel blows of his failures long before the middle of his life. If we take this into account, we see that our expression—Euripides brought the spectator onto the stage, in order to make the spectator truly capable of making judgments—was only provisional and that we have to seek out a deeper understanding of his dramatic tendencies. By contrast, it is, in fact, well known everywhere how Aeschylus and Sophocles during their lifetimes and, indeed, well beyond that, stood in full possession of popular

favour, and thus, given these predecessors of Euripides, there is no point in talking about a misunderstanding between the art work and the public. What drove the richly talented artist constantly under pressure to create so powerfully away from the path above which shone the sun of the greatest poetic names and the cloudless sky of popular approval? What curious consideration for the spectator led him to go against the spectator? How could he be contemptuous of his public out of a high respect for his public? The solution to the riddle posed immediately above is this: Euripides felt himself as a poet quite superior to the masses, but not superior to two of his spectators. He brought the masses up onto the stage. Those two spectators he honoured as the only judges capable of rendering a verdict and as masters of all his art; following their instructions and reminders, he transposed the entire world of feelings, passions, and experiences, which up to that point had appeared in the rows of spectators as an invisible chorus for every celebratory presentation, into the souls of his stage heroes. Following the demands of these two judges, he also sought out for these new characters a new language and a new tone. In the vote of these two spectators alone he heard a valid judgment of his creation, just as he heard their encouragement promising victory, when he saw himself once again condemned by the justice of the general public. The first of these two spectators is Euripides himself, Euripides the thinker, not the poet. Of him we could say that the extraordinary richness of his critical talent, like that of Lessing, constantly fostered, even if it did not create, an additional productive artistic drive.⁽⁵⁸⁾ Given this talent, with all the clarity and agility of his critical thinking, Euripides sat in the theatre and struggled to recognize the masterpieces of his great predecessors, as with a painting darkened by age, feature by feature, line by line. And here he now encountered something not unfamiliar to those who know the profound secrets of Aeschylean tragedy: he became aware of something incommensurable in every feature and in every line, a certain deceptive clarity and, at the same time, an enigmatic depth, the infinity of the background. The clearest figure still had a comet's tail attached to it, which seemed to hint at the unknown, the inexplicable. The same duality lay over the construction of the drama, as well as over the meaning of the chorus. And how ambiguously the solution of the ethical problems remained for him! How questionable the handling of the myths! How unequal the division of luck and disaster! Even in the language of the older tragedies there was a great deal he found offensive or, at least, enigmatic. He especially found too much pomp and circumstance for simple relationships, too many figures of speech and monstrosities for straightforward characters. And thus he sat there in the theatre, full of uneasy thoughts, and, as a spectator, he came to realize that he did not understand his great predecessors. But since his reason counted for him as the real root of all enjoyment and creativity, he had to question himself and look around to see if

there was anyone who thought the way he did and could in the same way attest to that incommensurate quality of the old drama. But the public, including the best individuals among them, met him only with a suspicious smile. No one could explain to him why his reflections about and objections to the great masters might be correct. And in this agonizing condition he found the other spectator, who did not understand tragedy and therefore did not value it. United with him, Euripides could dare to begin emerging from his isolation to launch the immense battle against the art works of Aeschylus and Sophocles—not with critical writings, but as a dramatic poet, who sets up his idea of tragedy in opposition to the tradition. 12 Before we designate this other spectator by name, let's linger here a moment to call to mind for ourselves that impression of the duality and incommensurability at the heart of Aeschylean tragedy, something we described earlier. Let us think about our own surprise at and unease with the chorus and the tragic hero of those tragedies, both of which we did not know how to reconcile with what we are used to any more than with the tradition—until we again recognized that duality itself as the origin and essence of Greek tragedy, as the expression of two artistic drives woven together, the Apollonian and the Dionysian. To cut that primordial and all-powerful Dionysian element out of tragedy and to rebuild tragedy as a pure, new, and un-Dionysian art, morality, and world view—that has now revealed itself to us very clearly as the tendency of Euripides. Near the end of his life, Euripides himself proposed as emphatically as possible for his contemporaries the question about the value and meaning of this tendency in a myth. Should the Dionysian exist at all? Should we not eradicate it forcefully from Greek soil? Of course we should, the poet says to us, if only it were possible, but the god Dionysus is too powerful. The most sensible opponent—like Pentheus in the *Bacchae*—is unexpectedly charmed by Dionysus and later runs in this enchanted state to his own destruction. The judgment of the two old men, Cadmus and Teiresias, seems also to be the judgment of the aged poet: the thinking of the cleverest individual does not throw away that old folk tradition, that eternally propagating reverence for Dionysus; indeed, where such amazing powers are concerned, it is appropriate at least to demonstrate a diplomatically prudent show of joining in. But even with that, it is still possible that the god might take offence at such lukewarm participation and in the end transform the diplomat into a dragon—as happens here with Cadmus.(59) The poet tells us this, a poet who fought throughout his long life against Dionysus with heroic force—only to conclude his life with a glorification of his opponent and a suicide, like a man suffering from vertigo who, in order to escape the dreadful dizziness, which he can no longer endure, throws himself off a tower. That tragedy [*Bacchae*] is a protest against the practicality of his artistic program [Tendenz], alas, and it had already succeeded! A miracle had taken place: just when the poet recanted, his program had already triumphed. Dionysus had

already been chased off the tragic stage, and by a daemonic power speaking out from Euripides. But Euripides was, in a certain sense, only a mask: the divinity which spoke out of him was not Dionysus, and not Apollo, but an entirely new-born daemon called Socrates. This is the new opposition: the Dionysian and the Socratic. And from this contrast, Greek tragedy perished as a work of art. No matter how much Euripides might now seek to console us with his retraction, he was unsuccessful: the most magnificent temple lay in ruins. What use to us are the laments of the destroyer and his awareness that it had been the most beautiful of all temples? And even if Euripides himself, as a punishment, has been turned into a dragon by the artistic critics of all ages—who can be satisfied with this paltry compensation? Let us get closer now to this Socratic trend, with which Euripides fought against and conquered Aeschylean tragedy. What purpose—that’s the question we need to ask ourselves at this point—could Euripides’ intention to ground drama solely on the un-Dionysian have generally had, if we assume its implementation had the very highest ideals? What form of drama still remained, if it was not to be born from the womb of music, in that mysterious half-light of the Dionysian? All it could be was dramatic epic, an Apollonian art form, in which the tragic effect is naturally unattainable. This is not a matter of the content of the represented events. Indeed, I could assert that in Goethe’s proposed *Nausikaa* it would have been impossible to make the suicide of that idyllic being—which was to be carried out in the fifth act—grippingly tragic, for the power of the Apollonian epic is so extraordinary that right before our very eyes it magically transforms the most horrific things through that joy in and redemption through appearances. The poet of the dramatic epic cannot completely fuse with his pictures, any more than the epic rhapsodist can: it is still a matter of calm, tranquil contemplation, looking with open eyes, a state which sees the images in front of it. The actor in this dramatized epic still remains, in the most profound sense, a rhapsodist; the consecration of the inner dream lies upon all his actions, so that he is never completely an actor. Now, how is Euripides’ work related to this ideal of Apollonian drama? It is just like the relationship of the solemn rhapsodist of the olden times to that younger attitude, whose nature is described in Plato’s *Ion* as follows: “When I say something sad, my eyes fill with tears. But if what I say is horrifying and terrible, then the hairs on my head stand on end from fright, and my heart beats loudly.” Here we no longer see the epic dissolution of being in appearances, the disinterested coolness of the real actor, who remains, particularly in his most intense activity, totally appearance and delight in appearances. Euripides is the actor with the beating heart, with his hair standing on end. He designs his work as a Socratic thinker, and he carries it out as a passionate actor. Euripides is a pure artist neither in planning his work nor in carrying it out. Thus, the Euripidean drama is simultaneously a cool and fiery thing, equally capable of freezing or burning. It

is impossible for it to attain the Apollonian effect of the epic, while, on the other hand, it has divorced itself as much as possible from the Dionysian elements, and now, in order to work at all, it needs new ways to arouse people, methods which can no longer lie within either of the two individual artistic drives of the Apollonian and the Dionysian. These methods of arousing people are detached paradoxical ideas—substituted for Apollonian objects of contemplation—and fiery emotions—substituted for Dionysian enchantment. The fiery effects are, to be sure, imitated with the highest degree of realism, but the ideas and emotional effects are not in the slightest imbued with the spirit of art. Hence, if we have recognized this much, that Euripides was not at all successful in basing his drama solely on Apollonian principles, that, by contrast, his un-Dionysian tendencies led him astray into an inartistic naturalism, we will now be able to move closer to the essential quality of Socratic aesthetics, whose most important law runs something like this: “Everything must be understandable in order to be beautiful,” a corollary to the Socratic saying, “Only the knowledgeable person is virtuous.” With this canon in hand, Euripides assessed all the individual features and justified them according to this principle: the language, the characters, the dramatic construction, the choral music. What we habitually assess so frequently in Euripides as a poetical deficiency and a backward step, in comparison with Sophoclean tragedy, is for the most part the product of that emphatic critical process, that daring intelligence. Let the Euripidean prologue serve for us as an example of what that rationalistic method produces. Nothing can be more offensive to our stage techniques than the prologue in a Euripidean play. That a single person should step forward at the beginning of a work and explain who he is, what has gone on before the action starts, what has happened up to this point, and, indeed, what will occur in the unfolding of the work, that would strike a modern poetical dramatist as a wanton, inexcusable abandonment of the effect of suspense. If we, in fact, know everything which is going to happen, who will want to sit around waiting to see that it really does happen? For here there is nothing like the stimulating relationship between a prophetic dream and a real event which occurs later. Euripides thought quite differently about the matter. The effect of tragedy, he believed, never depended on epic suspense, on the tempting uncertainty about what would happen now and later. It depended far more on those great rhetorical-lyrical scenes in which the passion and dialectic of the main hero swelled up into a wide and powerful torrent. Everything was preparing for pathos, not for action, and what did not prepare the way for pathos was considered disposable. But the most serious barrier to the delighted devotion to such scenes is any part the spectator found missing, a gap in the network of the previous events. As long as the listener still has to figure out what this or that person means, what gives rise to this or that conflict in motives or purposes, then his full immersion in the suffering and action of the main characters, his

breathless sympathy with and fear for them, is not yet possible. The Aeschylean-Sophoclean tragedies made use of the most elegant artistic methods to provide the spectators in the opening scenes, as if by chance, all those necessary clues to understanding everything, a technique in which their noble artistry proves its worth by allowing the necessary features to appear, so to speak, as something masked and accidental. But for all that, Euripides believed he noticed that during those first scenes the spectator was oddly disturbed having to figure out the simple arithmetic of the previous events, so that the poetical beauties and the pathos of the exposition were lost on him. Therefore Euripides set up the prologue even before the exposition and put it in the mouth of a person whom people could trust—often a divinity had to more or less guarantee the outcome of the tragedy for the public and take away all doubts about the reality of the myth, in a manner similar to the way in which Descartes was able to establish the reality of the empirical world only through an appeal to the truthfulness of God and his inability to lie. At the end of his drama, Euripides once again made use of this same divine truthfulness in order to confirm his hero's future for the public. This is the function of the notorious *deus ex machina*.⁽⁶⁰⁾ Between the epic preview and final preview lay the lyrical, dramatic present, the essential "drama." So Euripides as a poet is, above all, the echo of his conscious knowledge, and it is precisely this which confers upon him such a memorable place in the history of Greek art. In view of his critically productive creativity it must have often struck him that he had to bring alive in drama the opening of Anaxagoras' text, the first lines of which go as follows: "In the beginning everything was confused, but then came reason and created order." And if, among philosophers, Anaxagoras, with his concept of *nous* [mind], seems like the first sober man among nothing but drunkards, so Euripides might have conceptualized his relationship to the other tragic poets with a similar image.⁽⁶¹⁾ So long as the single creator of order and ruler of all, (T)*nous* [mind](T), was still excluded from artistic creativity, everything was still mixed up in a chaotic primordial stew. That's how Euripides must have judged the matter; that's how he, as the first "sober" poet, must have passed sentence on the "drunken" poets. What Sophocles said about Aeschylus—that he does what's right, without being aware of it—was certainly not said in any Euripidean sense. Euripides would have conceded only that Aeschylus created improperly because he created without any conscious awareness. Even the god-like Plato speaks of how the creative capability of poets is not a conscious insight, but for the most part only ironically, and he draws a comparison with the talent of prophets and dream interpreters, since the poet is not able to write until he has lost his conscious mind and reason no longer resides in him. Euripides undertook the task, as Plato did, too, of showing the world the opposite of the "irrational" poet. His basic aesthetic principle, "Everything must be conscious in order to be beautiful," is, as

I have mentioned, the corollary of the Socratic saying, "Everything must be conscious in order to be good." With this in mind, we are entitled to assess Euripides as the poet of aesthetic Socratism. Socrates, however, was that second spectator, who did not understand the older tragedy and therefore did not value it. With Socrates as his ally, Euripides dared to be the herald of a new artistic creativity. If the older tragedy perished from this development, then aesthetic Socratism is the murdering principle. But insofar as the fight was directed against the Dionysian of the older art, we recognize in Socrates the enemy of Dionysus, the new Orpheus, who roused himself against Dionysus, and who, although destined to be torn apart by the maenads of the Athenian Court of Justice, nevertheless compelled the overpowering god himself to run away.(62)

Dionysus, as before, when he fled from Lycurgus, king of the Edoni, saved himself in the depths of the sea, that is, in the mysterious floods of a secret cult which would gradually overrun the entire world. 13 That Socrates had a close relationship to Euripides' attitude did not escape their contemporaries in ancient times, and the clearest illustration of this happy intuition is that rumour running around Athens that Socrates was in the habit of helping Euripides with his poetry. Both names were linked by the supporters of the "good old days" when it was time to list the present popular leaders whose influence had brought about a situation in which the old sturdy fitness in mind and body manifested at the Battle of Marathon was being increasingly sacrificed for a dubious way of explaining things, in a continuing erosion of the physical and mental powers.(63)

This was the tone, half indignation, half contempt, in which Aristophanic comedy habitually talked of those men, to the horror of the newer generations, who, although happy enough to betray Euripides, could not contain their surprise that Socrates appeared in Aristophanes as the first and most important sophist, as the mirror and essence of all sophistic ambitions. Their only consolation for this was to pillory Aristophanes himself as an impudent lying Alcibiades of poetry. (64) Without here defending the profound instincts of Aristophanes against such attacks, I will proceed to demonstrate the close interrelationship between Socrates and Euripides as the ancients saw it. It's important to remember, in this connection, that Socrates, as an opponent of tragic art, did not attend the performances of tragedy and only joined the spectators when a new piece by Euripides was being produced. The best known link, however, is the close juxtaposition of both names in the pronouncements of the Delphic Oracle, which indicated that Socrates was the wisest of men and at the same time delivered the judgment that Euripides captured second prize in the contest for wisdom. Sophocles was the third person named in this hierarchy, the man who could praise himself in comparison with Aeschylus by saying that he (Sophocles) did what was right because he knew what was right. Obviously the particular degree of clarity in these men's knowledge was the factor that designated them

collectively as the three “wise men” of their time. But the most pointed statement about that new and unheard of high opinion of knowledge and understanding was uttered by Socrates, when he claimed that he was the only person to assert that he knew nothing; whereas, in his critical wandering about in Athens conversing with the greatest statesmen, orators, poets, and artists, everywhere he ran into people who imagined they knew things. Astonished, he recognized that all these famous people themselves had no correct and clear insight into their careers and carried out their work only instinctually. “Only from instinct”—with this expression we touch upon the heart and centre of the Socratic attitude. Given this, Socratism condemns prevailing art as well as prevailing ethics. Wherever he directs his searching gaze, he sees a lack of insight and the power of delusion, and from this lack he infers the inner falsity and worthlessness of present conditions. On the basis of this one point, Socrates believed he had to correct existence. He, a solitary individual, stepped forward with an expression of contempt and superiority, as the pioneer of an entirely different style of culture, art, and morality, into a world, a scrap of which we would count an honour and the greatest good fortune to catch. That is the immensely disturbing thing which always grips us about Socrates and which over and over again stimulates us to find out the meaning and intention of this man, the most problematic figure of ancient times. Who is the man who can dare, as an individual, to deny the essence of Greece, which as Homer, Pindar, and Aeschylus, as Phidias, as Pericles, as Pythia, and Dionysus, as the most profound abyss and loftiest height, can count on our astonished veneration? What daemonic force is it that could dare to sprinkle this magic drink in the dust? What demigod is it to whom the ghostly chorus of the noblest specimens of humanity had to cry out: “Alas, alas! You have destroyed the beautiful world with your mighty fist. It is collapsing, falling to pieces!”(65) A key to the essence of Socrates is offered to us by that amazing phenomenon indicated by the term “Socrates’ daimonon.” Under special circumstances, in which his immense reasoning power was gripped by doubt, he got a firm clue from a divine voice which expressed itself at such times. When this voice came, it always sounded a cautionary note. In this totally anomalous character, instinctive wisdom reveals itself only in order to stand up now and then against conscious knowledge as a hindrance. Whereas in all productive men instinct is the truly creative and affirming power, and consciousness acts as a critical and cautioning reaction, in Socrates instinct becomes the critic, consciousness becomes the creator—truly a monstrosity per defectum [from some defect]! Indeed, we do perceive here a grotesque defectus [defect] of every mystical talent, so that Socrates can be considered a specific case of the non-mystical man, in whom the logical character has become simply too massive through excessive use, just like instinctive wisdom in the mystic. On the other hand, however, it was utterly impossible for that logical drive, as it appeared in

Socrates, to turn against itself. In its unfettered outpouring it demonstrates a natural force of the sort we meet, to our shuddering surprise, only in the very greatest of all instinctive powers. Anyone who has sensed in the Platonic texts the merest scent of that god-like naïveté and confidence in the direction of Socrates' life has also felt how that immense drive wheel of logical Socratism is in motion, as it were, behind Socrates and how we are compelled to see this through Socrates, as if we were looking through a shadow. That he himself had a premonition of this relationship comes out in the dignified seriousness with which he assessed his divine calling everywhere, even before his judges. To censure him for this was basically as impossible as to approve of his influence on the dissolution of instinct. When Socrates was hauled before the assembly of the Greek state, there was only one single form of sentence for this irreconcilable conflict, namely, banishment: people should have expelled him beyond the borders as something completely enigmatic, unclassifiable, inexplicable, so that some posterity could not justly indict the Athenians for acting shamefully. But the fact that death and not mere exile was pronounced over him Socrates himself appears to have brought about, fully clear about what he was doing and without the natural horror of death: he went to his death with that tranquillity Plato describes him showing as he leaves the Symposium, the last drinker in the early light of dawn, to start a new day, while behind him, on the benches and on the ground, his sleeping dinner companions remain, to dream of Socrates, the truly erotic man. The dying Socrates became the new ideal of the noble Greek youth, one never seen before. Above all, the typical Greek youth, Plato, prostrated himself before Socrates' image with all the fervent adoration of his passionately enthusiastic soul. 14 Let's now imagine that one great Cyclops eye of Socrates focussed on tragedy, that eye in which the beautiful madness of artistic enthusiasm never glowed—let's imagine how it was impossible for that eye to peer into the Dionysian abyss with a feeling of pleasure.(66) What must that eye have actually seen in the "lofty and highly praised" tragic art, as Plato calls it? Something really unreasonable—causes without effects and effects which seemed to have no causes, and the whole so confused and with so many different elements that any reasonable disposition had to reject it, but dangerous tinder for sensitive and susceptible souls. We know which single form of poetry Socrates understood: Aesop's Fables, and he certainly did so with that smiling complacency with which the noble and good Gellert in his fable of the bee and the hen sings the praises of poetry: You see in me the use of poetry— To tell the man without much sense A picture image of the truth of things.(67) But for Socrates tragic art did not seem "to speak the truth" at all, quite apart from the fact that it addressed itself to the man who "does not possess much sense," and thus not to philosophers, a double excuse to keep one's distance from it. Like Plato, he assigned it to the arts of cosmetics, which present only what is pleasant,

not what is useful, and he therefore made the demand that his disciples abstain and strictly stay away from such unphilosophical temptations, with so much success that the youthful poet of tragedy, Plato, immediately burned his poetical writing, so that he could become Socrates' student. But where invincible talents fought against the Socratic instructions, his power, together with the force of that immense personality, was still great enough to force poetry itself into new attitudes, unknown up until then. An example of this is Plato himself. To be sure, in his condemnation of tragedy and art in general he did not remain back behind the naive cynicism of his master. But completely from artistic necessity he had to create an art form inwardly related to the existing art forms which he had rejected. The major criticism which Plato had made about the older art—that it was the imitation of an illusion and thus belonged to an even lower level than the empirical world—must above all not be directed against the new work of art. And so we see Plato exerting himself to go beyond reality and to present the Idea which forms the basis of that pseudo-reality.⁽⁶⁸⁾ With that, however, Plato the thinker reached by a detour the very place where, as a poet, he had always been at home and from where Sophocles and all the older art was solemnly protesting against Plato's criticism. If tragedy had assimilated into itself all earlier forms of art, so the same again holds true, in an odd way, for the Platonic dialogue, which was created from a mixture of all available styles and forms and hovers between explanation, lyric, drama, between prose and poetry, right in the middle, and in so doing broke through the strict old law about the unity of stylistic form. The Cynic writers went even further along the same path. In the excessive garishness of their style, in their weaving back and forth between prose and metrical forms, they produced the literary image of "raving Socrates," which they were in the habit of depicting in their own lives.⁽⁶⁹⁾ The Platonic dialogue was, so to speak, the boat on which the shipwreck of the older poetry, along with all its children, was saved. Pushed together into a single narrow space and with Socrates at the helm they anxiously and humbly set off now into a new world, which never could get its fill of looking at fantastic images of this procession. Plato truly gave all future generations the image of a new form of art, the image of the novel, which can be characterized as an infinitely intensified Aesopian fable, in which poetry lived on with a relative priority to dialectical philosophy similar to the relative priority of that very philosophy to theology for many centuries, that is, as ancilla [subservient maid]. This was poetry's new position, the place into which Plato forced it under the pressure of the daemonic Socrates. Now philosophical ideas grew up around art and forced it to cling closely to the trunk of dialectic. The Apollonian attitude metamorphosed into logical systematizing, just as we noticed something similar with Euripides and, in addition, the Dionysian was transformed into naturalistic emotions. Socrates, the dialectical hero in Platonic drama, reminds us of the changed nature of the Euripidean hero, who has to

defend his actions with reasons and counter-reasons and thus often runs the risk of losing our tragic sympathy. For who can fail to recognize the optimistic element in the heart of dialectic, which celebrates a jubilee with every conclusion and can breathe only in cool brightness and consciousness, that optimistic element which, once it has penetrated tragedy, must gradually overrun its Dionysian regions and necessarily drive them to self-destruction—right to their death leap into middle-class drama. Let people merely recall the consequences of the Socratic sayings “Virtue is knowledge; sin arises only from ignorance; the virtuous person is the happy person”: in these three basic forms of optimism lies the death of tragedy. For now the virtuous hero must be a dialectician; now there must be a necessarily perceptible link between virtue and knowledge, belief and morality; now the transcendental resolution of justice in Aeschylus is lowered to the flat and impertinent principle of “poetic justice” with its customary *deus ex machina*. What does this new Socratic optimistic stage world think about the chorus and the whole musical-Dionysian foundation for tragedy in general? As something accidental, as a reminder of the origin of tragedy, which we can well do without. We, by contrast, have come to realize that the chorus can only be understood as the cause of tragedy and of the tragic in general. Already with Sophocles the issue of the chorus reveals something of an embarrassment—an important indication that even with him the Dionysian stage of tragedy is beginning to fall apart. He no longer dares to trust the chorus to carry the major share of the action, but limits its role to such an extent that it now appears almost coordinated with the actors, just as if it had been lifted up out of the orchestra into the scene. This feature naturally destroys its nature completely, no matter how much Aristotle may have approved of this particular arrangement of the chorus. That displacement of the chorus, which Sophocles certainly recommended through his dramatic practice and, according to tradition, even in a written text, is the first step toward the destruction of the chorus, whose phases in Euripides, Agathon, and the New Comedy followed one after the other with breakneck speed. Optimistic dialectic, with its syllogistic whip, drove music out of tragedy; that is, it destroyed the essence of tragedy, which can be interpreted only as a manifestation and representation of Dionysian states, as a perceptible symbolizing of music, as the dream world of a Dionysian intoxication. If we have thus noticed an anti-Dionysian tendency already effective even before Socrates, which only in him achieves incredible, brilliant expression, then we must not shrink from the question of where such a phenomenon as Socrates points to. For we are not in a position, given the Platonic dialogues, to see that phenomenon merely as a negative force of dissolution. And so, while it’s true that the most immediate effect of the Socratic drive was to bring about the subversion of Dionysian tragedy, a profound living experience of Socrates himself forces us to the question whether there must necessarily be only an

antithetical relationship between Socratism and art and whether the birth of an “artistic Socrates” is in general an inherent contradiction. For where art is concerned, that despotic logician now and then had the feeling of a gap, of an emptiness, of a partial reproach, of a duty he had perhaps neglected. As he explains to his friends in prison, one and the same dream apparition often came to him, always with the same words, “Socrates, practice music!” He calmed himself, right up to his last days, with the interpretation that his practice of philosophy was the highest musical art and believed that it was incorrect that a divinity would remind him of “common, popular music.” Finally in prison, in order to relieve his conscience completely, he agreed to practice that music, something he had considered insignificant. And in this mood, he composed a poem to Apollo and rendered a few of Aesop’s fables in verse. What drove him to this practice was something like the voice of his warning daemon: it was his Apollonian insight that, like a barbarian king, he did not understand a noble divine image and was in danger of sinning against a divinity—through his failure to understand. That statement of Socrates’ dream vision is the single indication of his thinking about something perhaps beyond the borders of his logical nature. So he had to ask himself: Is something which I do not understand not also something incomprehensible? Perhaps there is a kingdom of wisdom which is forbidden to the logician? Perhaps art is even a necessary correlative and supplement to scientific understanding? 15 In the sense of this last mysterious question we must now state how the influence of Socrates has spread out over later worlds, right up to this moment and, indeed, into all future ages, like a shadow in the evening sun constantly growing larger, how that influence always makes necessary the re-creation of art—I mean art in its most profound and widest metaphysical sense—and through its own immortality guarantees the immortality of art. Before we could recognize this fact, before we convincingly established the innermost dependence of every art on the Greeks, from Homer right up to Socrates, we had to treat these Greeks as the Athenians treated Socrates. Almost every era and cultural stage has at some point sought in a profoundly ill-tempered frame of mind to free itself of the Greeks, because in comparison with the Greeks, all their own achievements, apparently fully original and admired in all sincerity, suddenly appeared to lose their colour and life and shrivelled to unsuccessful copies, in fact, to caricatures. And so a heartfelt inner anger always keeps breaking out again against that arrogant little nation which dared to designate for all time everything that was not produced in its own country as “barbaric.” Who were those Greeks, people asked themselves, who, although they had achieved only an ephemeral historical glitter, only ridiculously restricted institutions, only an ambiguous competence in morality, who could even be identified with hateful vices, yet who had nevertheless laid a claim to a dignity and a pre-eminent place among peoples, appropriate to a

genius among the masses? Unfortunately people were not lucky enough to find the cup of hemlock which could easily do away with such a being, for all the poisons which envy, slander, and inner rage created were insufficient to destroy that self-satisfied magnificence. Hence, confronted by the Greeks, people have been ashamed and afraid, unless an individual values the truth above everything else and dares to propose this truth: the notion that the Greeks, as the charioteers of our culture and every other one, hold the reins, but that almost always the wagon and horses are inferior material and do not match the glory of their drivers, who then consider it amusing to whip such a team into the abyss, over which they themselves jump with the leap of Achilles. To demonstrate that Socrates also merits a place among the drivers of the chariot, it is sufficient to recognize him as typifying a form of existence inconceivable before him, the type known as The Theoretical Man. Our next task is to reach some insight about the meaning and purpose of such a man. The theoretical man, like the artist, also takes an infinite satisfaction in the present and is, like the artist, protected by that satisfaction from the practical ethic of pessimism and from its lynx eyes which glow only in the darkness. For while the artist, with each revelation of the truth, always keeps his enchanted gaze hanging on what still remains hidden after his revelation, theoretical man enjoys and remains satisfied with the covers which have been cast aside and takes as the greatest object of delight the process of continually happy unveiling which his own power has brought about. There would be no science if it concerned itself only with that one naked goddess and with nothing else. For then its disciples would have to feel like people who wanted to dig a hole straight through the earth, and each of them sees that, even with the greatest lifelong effort, he is in a position to dig through only a really small piece of the immense depths, and that piece will be covered over in front of his eyes by the work of the person who comes after him, so that a third person would apparently do well to select on his own initiative a new place for his tunneling efforts. Well, if someone now convincingly demonstrates that it is impossible to reach the antipodes by this direct route, who will still want to continue working on in the old depths, unless in the meantime he lets himself be satisfied with the possibility of finding some valuable rock or discovering some natural law? For that reason, Lessing, the most honest theoretical man, ventured to state that for him the search for the truth counted for more than truth itself. With that statement the fundamental secret of science is unmasked, to the astonishment, indeed, the anger, of scientists. Now, of course, alongside occasional recognitions like Lessing's, prompted by excessive honesty if not high spirits, stands a profound delusion, which first came into the world in the person of Socrates, the unshakeable faith that thinking, guided by the main idea of causality, might reach into the deepest abyss of being and that thinking is capable, not just of understanding being, but even of correcting it. This sublime

metaphysical delusion is instinctually part of science and leads it over and over again to its limits, at which point it must turn into art, something which is really predictable with this mechanical process. With the torch of this idea, let's now look at Socrates: to us he appears as the first person who was capable not only of living by that instinct for science, but also—something much more—of dying by it, and thus the picture of the dying Socrates as a man raised above fear of death by knowledge and reason is the shield hanging over the entranceway to science, reminding every individual of his purpose, namely, to make existence intelligible and thus apparently justified. Of course, when reasoning cannot succeed in this endeavour, myth must also finally serve, something which I have just noted as the necessary consequence, indeed, even the purpose, of science. Once anyone clearly sees how, after Socrates, that mystagogue of science, one philosophical school succeeds another in sequence, like wave after wave, how a never-imagined universal greed for knowledge throughout the widest extent of the educated world steered science around on the high seas as the essential task for every person of greater capabilities, a greed which it has been impossible since then completely to expel from science, how through this universality a common net of thinking was cast over the entire earth for the first time, with prospects, in fact, of the rule-bound workings of an entire solar system—whoever reminds himself of all this, together with that astonishingly high pyramid of contemporary knowledge, cannot deny the fact that in Socrates we see a turning point and vortex of so-called world history. Then imagine for a moment if the entire incalculable sum of the energy which has been used in pursuit of that world project were spent, not in the service of knowledge, but on the practical, that is, the egotistical, aims of individuals and peoples, then in all probability the instinctive delight in living would be so weakened by universal wars of destruction and continuing migrations of people that, with suicide being a common occurrence, perhaps the individual would have had to feel the final remnant of a sense of duty, when he, like the inhabitants of the Fiji Islands, as a son would strangle his parents, and as a friend would strangle his friend—a practical pessimism, which could even give rise to a dreadful ethic of mass murder out of sympathy—an ethic which, by the way, is present and has been present all over the world, wherever art has not appeared in some form or other, especially in religion and science, as a remedy and a defence against that miasma. With respect to this practical pessimism, Socrates is the original picture of the theoretical optimist, who, as I have described, in the belief that we could come to understand the nature of things, thinks that the power of a universal medicine is contained in knowledge and discovery and that evil inherently consists of error. To push forward with that reasoning and to separate true knowledge from appearance and from error seemed to the Socratic man the noblest, even the single truly human, vocation, and so from Socrates on, that

mechanism of ideas, judgments, and conclusions has been valued as the highest activity and the most admirable gift of nature, above all other capabilities. Even the noblest moral deeds, the emotions of pity, of self-sacrifice, of heroism and that calmness in the soul, so difficult to attain, which the Apollonian Greeks called *sophrosyne*—all these were derived by Socrates and his like-minded descendants right up to the present time from the dialectic of knowledge and therefore described as teachable. Whoever has experienced for himself the delight of a Socratic discovery and feels how this, in ever-widening circles, seeks to enclose the entire world of phenomena, will from then on find no spur capable of pushing him into existence more intense than the desire to complete that conquest and to weave a solid impenetrable net. To a man so minded, the Platonic Socrates then appears as the teacher of an entirely new form of “Greek serenity” and of a blissful existence, which seeks to discharge itself in actions and which will find this discharge, for the most part, in those influences which come from acting as a midwife to and educating noble disciples, in order finally to produce a genius. But now science, incited by its powerful delusion, speeds on inexorably right to its limits, at which point the optimism hidden in the essence of logic breaks down. For the circumference of the circle of science has an infinity of points, and while it is still impossible to see how that circumference could ever be completely measured, nevertheless the noble, talented man, before the middle of his life, inevitably comes up against such a border point on that circumference, where he stares out into something which cannot be illuminated. When, at this point, he sees to his horror how at these limits logic turns around on itself and finally bites its own tail—then a new form of knowledge breaks through, tragic insight, which, in order merely to be endured, requires art as a protector and healer. If we look at the loftiest realms of that world streaming around us, our eyes strengthened and refreshed by the Greeks, we become aware of that greed of insatiably optimistic knowledge, exemplary in Socrates, turning into tragic resignation and a need for art, even if it’s true that this same greed, at its lower levels, must express itself as hostile to art and must inwardly loathe Dionysian tragic art in particular, as I have already explained in the example of the conflict between Aeschylean tragedy and Socratism. Here we are now knocking, with turbulent feelings, on the doors of the present and future: Will that “turning around” lead to continuously new configurations of genius and straight to the music-playing Socrates? Will that net of art spread out over existence, whether in the name of religion or of science, be woven always more tightly and delicately, or is it determined that it will be ripped to shreds by the restless barbaric impulses and hurly-burly which we now call “the present”?—We are standing here on the sidelines for a little while as lookers on, worried but not without hope, for we are being permitted to witness that immense struggle and transition. Alas! The magic of these battles is that whoever looks at them

must also fight them! 16 By setting out this historical example, we have attempted to clarify how tragedy just as surely dies away with the disappearance of the spirit of music, as it can be born only out of this spirit. To mitigate the strangeness of this claim and, on the other hand, to indicate the origin of this insight of ours, we must now openly face up to analogous phenomena of the present time. We must stride right into the midst of those battles which, as I have just said, are being waged in the loftiest spheres of our present world between the insatiably optimistic desire to know and the tragic need for art. In this discussion, I shall omit all the other opposing drives which have in every age worked against art, especially against tragedy, and which at present have also taken hold with such confidence of victory that, for example, in the art of the theatre, only farces and ballets produce fragrant blossoms with a reasonably luxurious bloom, which is perhaps not for everyone. I shall speak only of the most illustrious opposition to the tragic world view: by that I mean scientific knowledge, optimistic to the deepest core of its being, with its father Socrates at the very pinnacle. Shortly I shall also indicate by name the forces which seem to me to guarantee a rebirth of tragedy—and who knows what other blessed hopes for the German character! Before we leap into the middle of that battle, let us wrap ourselves in the armour of the insights we seized upon earlier. In opposition to all those eager to derive art from a single principle as the necessary living origin of every work of art, I keep my eyes fixed on both those artistic divinities of the Greeks, Apollo and Dionysus, and recognize in them the living and clear representatives of two art worlds, different in their deepest being and their highest goals. Apollo stands before me as the transfigured genius of the principium individuationis, through which release is only to be truly attained through illusion; whereas, under the mystical joyous cries of Dionysus, the spell of individuation is shattered, and the way lies open to the maternal source of being, to the innermost core of things. This tremendous difference, which opens up a yawning gap between plastic art as the Apollonian and music as the Dionysian art, became obvious to only one of the great thinkers, to the extent that he, even without that prompting from the symbolism of the Greek gods, recognized for music a character and origin different from all the other arts, because music is not, like all those others, the image of appearance, but an immediate portrayal of the will itself and also because it presents the metaphysical as compared to all physical things in the world, the thing-in-itself in comparison with all appearances (Schopenhauer, *World as Will and Idea*, I.1.3.52). On this most significant insight into all aesthetics, which, taken seriously, marks the first beginning of aesthetics, Richard Wagner, as confirmation of its lasting truth, set his stamp, when he established in Beethoven that music must be assessed on aesthetic principles entirely different from those for all fine arts and not at all according to the category of beauty, although an erroneous aesthetics in the service of a

misleading and degenerate art, had, because of that idea of beauty asserting itself in the world of images, become accustomed to demand from music an effect similar to what it demanded from works of the plastic arts, namely, the arousal of satisfaction in beautiful forms. After the discovery of that tremendous opposition, I sensed a strong urge to bring myself closer to the essence of Greek tragedy and, in so doing, to the most profound revelation of the Hellenic genius. Only now did I believe I was capable of the magical task of posing the basic problem of tragedy vividly in my own mind, over and above the jargon of our customary aesthetics. Through that, I was granted such a strange, idiosyncratic glimpse into the Hellenic that it had to appear to me as if our classical-Hellenic scholarship, which behaves so proudly, had up to this point known, for the most part, only how to gloat over games with shadows and trivialities. Perhaps we can touch on that original problem with the following question: What aesthetic effect arises when those inherently separate powers of art, the Apollonian and the Dionysian, come to operate alongside each other? Or, put more briefly, what is the relationship of music to images and ideas? Schopenhauer, whom Richard Wagner applauded on this very point for the unsurpassable clarity and perceptiveness of his explanation, spoke his views on this matter in the greatest detail in the following place, which I will quote again here in full, from *World as Will and Idea*, I, p. 309: "As a result of all this, we can look upon the world of appearance, or nature, and music as two different expressions of the same thing, which itself is thus the only mediating factor in the analogy between the two of them; thus, an insight into this mediating factor is required in order to understand that analogy. According to this, music, when considered as an expression of the world, is to the highest degree a universal language, something which even has a relationship with the universality of ideas, rather like the way these are related to particular things. Its universality, however, is in no way that empty universality of abstractions, but something of an entirely different kind, bound up with a thoroughly clear certainty. In this, music is like geometric figures and numbers, which are the universal forms of all possible objects of experience and applicable to them all a priori, not, however, in an abstract manner but vividly and thoroughly fixed. All possible efforts, excitements, and manifestations of the will, all those processes inside human beings, which reason subsumes under the broad negative concept of feelings, can be expressed through the infinite number of possible melodies, but always in the universality of mere form, without matter, always only according to the thing-in-itself, not according to its appearance; they are, so to speak, its innermost soul, without the body. From this intimate relationship which music has with the true essence of all things, we can also account for the fact that when an appropriate music is heard in any scene, business, action, or environment, this music appears to open up to us the most secret sense of these things and comes forward as the most correct and clearest

commentary on them, in the same way that for the man who surrenders himself entirely to the experience of a symphony it is as if he saw all possible events of life and of the world drawn over into himself, and yet he cannot, if he thinks about it, perceive any similarity between that play of sounds and the things which are in his mind. For music is, as mentioned, different from all other arts in this sense: it is not a portrayal of appearances, or more correctly, the adequate objectification of the will, but the immediate portrayal of the will itself, as well as the metaphysical complement of all physical things in the world and the thing-in-itself of all appearances. We could, therefore, call the world the embodiment of music just as much as the embodiment of the will. And that is why it is understandable that music is capable of bringing out every painting, indeed, every scene of real life and the world with an immediate and higher significance and, of course, to do that all the more, the closer the analogy of its melody is to the inner spirit of the given phenomenon. On this point we base the fact that we can set a poem to music as a song, or a vivid presentation as a pantomime, or both as an opera. Such individual pictures of human life, given a foundation in the universal language of music, are never bound to music and do not correspond with music by some constant necessity, but stand in relation to music as a random example to a universal idea. They present in the clarity of the real the very thing which music expresses in the universality of mere form. For melodies are, to a certain extent, like general ideas, an (T)abstractum [abstraction](T) from the reality. For reality, that is, the world of individual things, supplies clear phenomena, remarkable and individual things, the single case, to both the universality of ideas and to the universality of melodies. Both of these universals, however, are, from a certain point of view, contrary to each other, since ideas consist only of forms abstracted first of all from perception, the stripped-away outer skin of things, so to speak, and are thus really and entirely abstracta [abstractions]; music, by contrast, gives the heart of the thing, the innermost core, which comes before all particular forms. This relationship can be really well expressed in the language of the scholastics, when we say: ideas are the *universalia post rem* [universals after the fact](T); music, however, gives the *universalia ante rem* [universals before the fact], and reality the *universalia in re* [universals in the fact]. That in general there can be a connection between a musical composition and a perceptible presentation, however, rests on the point that, as stated, both are only very different expressions of same inner essence of the world. Now, when in a particular case such a connection is truly present, that is, the composer has known how to express in the universal language of music the dynamic of the will, which constitutes the core of an event, then the melody of the song, the music of the opera, is full of expression. But the analogy discovered by the composer between those two must issue from his immediate insight into the world's essence, unknown to his reason, and must not be an

imitation, conveyed in ideas with conscious intentionality. Otherwise the music does not express the inner essence, the will itself, but only gives an inadequate imitation of its appearance, the way all essentially imitative music does.” Following what Schopenhauer has taught, we also understand music as the language of the unmediated will and feel our imaginations stirred to shape that spirit world which speaks to us invisibly and nonetheless with such vital movement and to embody it for ourselves in an analogous illustration. By contrast, image and idea, under the influence of a truly appropriate music, reach an elevated significance. Thus, Dionysian art customarily works in two ways on Apollonian artistic potential: music stimulates us to the metaphorical viewing of the Dionysian universality, and music then permits that metaphorical image to come forward with the highest significance. From this inherently intelligible observation and without any deeper considerations of unapproachable things, I conclude that music is capable of generating myth, that is, the most meaningful example, and of giving birth in particular to the tragic myth, the myth which speaks in metaphors of the Dionysian insight. I have explained in the phenomenon of the lyric poet, how the music in the lyric poet strives to make its essence known through him in Apollonian pictures. If we now imagine that music at its highest intensity must also seek to reach its highest representation, then we must consider it possible that music also knows how to find the symbolic expression for its essentially Dionysian wisdom. And where else will we have to look for this expression, if not in tragedy and in the idea of the tragic generally? From the essence of art as it is commonly understood according to the single categories of illusion and beauty, it is genuinely impossible to derive the tragic. Only with reference to the spirit of music do we understand a joy in the destruction of the individual. For in particular examples of such a destruction is made clear to us the eternal phenomenon of Dionysian art, which brings into expression the will in its omnipotence out from behind, so to speak, the *principio individuationis*, the eternal life beyond all appearances and in spite of all destruction. The metaphysical joy in the tragic is a translation of the instinctive unconscious Dionysian wisdom into the language of the image: the hero, the highest manifestation of the will, is destroyed, and we are happy at that, because, after all, he is only an illusion, and the eternal life of the will is not disturbed by his destruction. “We believe in eternal life,” so tragedy calls out, while the music is the direct idea of this life. The work of the plastic artist has an entirely different purpose: here Apollo overcomes the suffering of the individual through the bright exaltation in the eternity of the illusion. Here beauty is victorious over the suffering inherent in life. The pain is, in a certain sense, brushed away from the face of nature. In Dionysian art and in its tragic symbolism this same nature speaks to us with its true, undisguised voice: “Be as I am! Under the incessant changes in phenomena, the eternally creative primordial mother, eternally

forcing things into existence, eternally satisfied with the changing nature of appearances!" 17 Dionysian art thus wishes to convince us of the eternal delight in existence: only we are to seek this delight, not in appearances, but behind them; we are to recognize how everything which comes into being must be ready for painful destruction; we are forced to gaze directly into the terror of individual existence—and nonetheless are not to become paralyzed: a metaphysical consolation tears us momentarily out of the hustle and bustle of changing forms. For a short time we really are the primordial essence itself and feel its unbridled lust for and joy in existence; the struggle, the torment, the destruction of appearances now seem to us necessary, on account of the excess of innumerable forms of existence pressing and punching themselves into life and of the exuberant fecundity of the world will. We are transfixed by the raging barbs of this torment in the very moment when we become, as it were, one with the immeasurable primordial delight in existence and when, in Dionysian rapture, we sense the indestructible and eternal nature of this joy. In spite of fear and pity, we are fortunate vital beings, not as individuals, but as the one living being, with whose procreative joy we have been fused. The story of how Greek tragedy arose tells us now with clear certainty how the Greeks' tragic work of art really was born out of the spirit of music. With this idea we think we have, for the first time, done justice to the original and astonishing meaning of the chorus. At the same time, however, we must concede that the significance of the tragic myth established previously was never conceptually and transparently clear to the Greek poets, to say nothing of the Greek philosophers. Their heroes speak to a certain extent more superficially than they act; the myth really does not find its adequate objectification in the spoken word. The structure of the scenes and the vivid images reveal a deeper wisdom than the poet himself can grasp in words and ideas. We can make the same observation about Shakespeare, whose Hamlet, for example, in a similar sense speaks more superficially than he acts, so that we derive the doctrine of Hamlet we discussed earlier, not from the words, but from the deeper view and review of the totality of the work. With respect to Greek tragedy, which, of course, comes to us only as a drama of words, I have even suggested that the incongruity between myth and word can easily seduce us into considering it shallower and more empty of meaning than it is and thus also into assuming a more superficial effect than it must have had according to the testimony of the ancients, for we easily forget that what the poet as a wordsmith could not achieve, the attainment of the highest intellectualization and idealization of myth, he could have achieved successfully at any moment as a creative musician! Admittedly we are almost forced to recreate through scholarship the extraordinary power of the musical effects in order to experience something of that incomparable consolation necessarily characteristic of true tragedy. But we would experience this superior musical power for what it is only

if we ourselves were Greeks; whereas, considering the entire development of Greek music in comparison to the music we know and are familiar with—so infinitely richer by comparison—we believe that we are hearing youthful songs of musical genius, sung with only a timid sense of their power. The Greeks are, as the Egyptian priests say, eternal children and, even in tragic art, only children who do not know what a sublime toy has arisen under their hands, something which—will be destroyed. That struggle of the spirit of music for pictorial and mythic revelation, which becomes increasingly intense from the beginning of the lyric right up to Attic tragedy, suddenly breaks apart, right after it first attained full luxuriant bloom and, so to speak, disappears from the surface of Hellenic art, although the Dionysian world view born out of this struggle lives on in the mysteries and, in the most amazing transformations and degenerations, never stops attracting more serious natures to it. Is it not possible that one day it will rise from its mystic depths as art once more? At this point we are concerned with the question whether the power whose opposition broke tragedy has sufficient force for all time to hinder the artistic reawakening of tragedy and the tragic world view. If the old tragedy was derailed by the dialectical drive for knowledge and for the optimism of science, we might have to infer from this fact an eternal struggle between the theoretical and the tragic world view, and only after the spirit of science is taken right to its limits and its claim to universal validity destroyed by the proof of those limits would it be possible to hope for a rebirth of tragedy. For a symbol of such a cultural form, we would have to set up Socrates the player of music, in the sense talked about earlier. By this confrontation I understand with respect to the spirit of science that belief, which first came to light in the person of Socrates, that nature can be rationally understood and that knowledge has a universal healing power. Anyone who remembers the most immediate consequences of this restless, forward-driving spirit of science will immediately recall how it destroyed myth and how, through this destruction, poetry was driven out of its naturally ideal soil as something which from now on was without a home. If we have correctly ascribed to music the power to be able to bring about out of itself a rebirth of myth, then we will also have to seek out the spirit of science on the path where it has its hostile encounter with the myth-creating power of music. This occurred in the development of the new Attic dithyramb, whose music no longer expressed the inner essence, the will itself, but only gave back an inadequate appearance in an imitation delivered through ideas. From such inwardly degenerate music those with a true musical nature turned away with the same aversion which they had shown when confronted by the art-killing attitude of Socrates. The instinct of Aristophanes, which had such a sure grasp, was certainly right when he linked together Socrates himself, the tragedies of Euripides, and the music of the new writers of dithyrambs, hating each of them equally and smelling in all three phenomena the characteristics of a

degenerate culture. Through that newer dithyramb, music was, in an outrageous manner, turned into a mimetic demonstration of appearances, for example, a battle, a storm at sea, and in the process was certainly robbed of all its power to create myths. For when music seeks to arouse our indulgence only by compelling us to look for external analogies between an event in life and nature and certain rhythmic figures and characteristic musical sounds, when our understanding is supposed to be satisfied with the recognition of these analogies, then we are dragged down into a mood in which a conception of the mythic is impossible, for myth desires to be vividly felt as a single instance of universality and truth staring into the infinite. Truly Dionysian music confronts us as such a universal mirror of the world will: that vivid event reflected in this mirror widens out at once for our feelings into the image of an eternal truth. By contrast, in the sound painting of the newer dithyramb such a vivid event is immediately stripped of every mythic character. Now the music has become a feeble copy of the phenomenon and, in the process, infinitely poorer than the phenomenon itself. Through this impoverishment the phenomenon itself is even lowered in our feelings, so that now, for example, a battle imitated in this kind of music exhausts itself in marches, trumpet calls, and so forth, and our imagination is held back by these very superficialities. Painting with music is thus in every respect the opposite to the myth-creating power of true music: through the former a phenomenon becomes even more impoverished than it is; whereas, through Dionysian music the individual phenomenon becomes richer and widens into a world picture. It was a powerful victory of the non-Dionysian spirit when, in the development of the newer dithyramb, it alienated music from itself and forced it down to be the slave of appearances. Euripides, who, in a higher sense, must be considered a thoroughly unmusical nature, is for this very reason an ardent supporter of the newer dithyrambic music and uses all its stock effects and styles with the open-handedness of a thief. From another perspective we see the force of this un-Dionysian spirit in action directing its effects against myth, when we turn our gaze toward the way in which the presentation of character and the psychological complexities increase alarmingly in the tragedies of Sophocles. The character can no longer be allowed to broaden out into an eternal type, but, by contrast, must come across as an individual because of the artistic qualifications and shading and the most delicate clarity of every line, so that the spectator generally no longer experiences the myth but the commanding naturalism of the artist, his power of imitation. Here, as a result, we also become aware of the victory of appearances over the universal and of the delight in the particular, like an anatomical specimen, as it were. Already we breathe the air of a theoretical world, which values the scientific insight higher than the artistic reflection of a universal principle. The movement along the line of increasingly typical characteristics quickly goes further. While Sophocles still paints whole

characters and yokes their sophisticated development to myth, Euripides already paints only large individual character traits, which are capable of expressing themselves in violent passions. In the newer Attic comedy there are only masks with one expression, silly old men, deceived pimps, and mischievous slaves in an inexhaustible repetition. Where now has the myth-building spirit of music gone? What is still left for music now is music either of excitement or of memory, that is, either a means of stimulating jaded and worn out nerves or sound painting. As far as the first is concerned, the text is largely irrelevant. Already in Euripides, when his heroes or chorus first start to sing, things get really out of hand. What must it have been like with his impertinent successors? However, the new un-Dionysian spirit manifests itself with the utmost clarity in the conclusions of the newer plays. In the old tragedy, the metaphysical consolation was there to feel at the conclusion. Without that, the delight in tragedy generally cannot be explained. The sound of reconciliation from another world echoes most purely perhaps in Oedipus at Colonus. Now, once the genius of music flew away from tragedy, tragedy is, in the strict sense of the term, dead: for out of what are people now supposed to be able to create that metaphysical consolation? Consequently, people looked for an earthly solution to tragic dissonance. After the hero was sufficiently tortured by fate, he received a well-earned reward in an impressive marriage, in divine tributes. The hero became a gladiator, to whom people occasionally gave his freedom, after he had been well beaten and was covered with wounds. The *deus ex machina* moved in to replace metaphysical consolation. I don't wish to claim that the tragic world view was completely destroyed everywhere by the surging spirit of the un-Dionysian: we know only that it must have fled out of art into the underworld, so to speak, degenerating into a secret cult. But over the widest surface area of Hellenic existence raged the consuming wind of that spirit which announces itself in that form of "Greek serenity" to which I have already referred earlier, as an impotent, unproductive delight in existence. This cheerfulness is the opposite of the marvellous "naïveté" of the older Greeks, which we must see, in accordance with its given characteristics, as the flowering of Apollonian culture, blossoming out of a dark abyss, as the victory over suffering and the wisdom of suffering, which the Hellenic will gains through its ability to mirror beauty. The noblest form of that other form of "Greek serenity," the Alexandrian, is the cheerfulness of the theoretical man. It manifests the same characteristic features I have just derived out of the spirit of the un-Dionysian—it fights against Dionysian wisdom and art; it strives to dissolve myth; in place of a metaphysical consolation, it sets an earthy consonance, indeed, a *deus ex machina* of its own, namely, the god of machines and crucibles, that is, the forces of nature spirits, recognized and used in the service of a higher egoism; it believes in correcting the world through knowledge, in a life guided by science, and thus is really in a position to confine

the individual man within the narrowest circle of soluble problems, inside which he can cheerfully say to life: "I want you. You are worth knowing." 18 It's an eternal phenomenon: the voracious will always finds a way to keep its creatures alive and to force them on to further living by an illusion spread over things. One man is fascinated by the Socratic desire for knowledge and the delusion that with it he will be able to heal the eternal wound of existence. Another is caught up by the seductive veil of artistic beauty fluttering before his eyes, still another by the metaphysical consolation that underneath the hurly-burly of appearances eternal life flows on indestructibly, to say nothing of the more common and almost even more powerful illusions which the will holds ready at all times. In general, these three stages of illusion are only for nobly endowed natures, those who especially feel with a more profound reluctance the weight and difficulty of existence and who have to be deceived out of this reluctance by these exquisite stimulants. Everything we call culture consists of these stimulants: depending on the proportions of the mixture we have a predominantly Socratic or artistic or tragic culture—or if you'll permit historical examples—there is either an Alexandrian or a Hellenic or a Buddhist culture. Our entire modern world is trapped in the net of Alexandrian culture and recognizes as its ideal the theoretical man, equipped with the highest intellectual powers and working in the service of science, a man for whom Socrates is the prototype and progenitor. All our methods of education originally have this ideal in view; every other existence has struggled on with difficulty alongside this ideal as a way of life we permit, not as one we desire. For a long time now, in an almost frightening sense, an educated person here has been found only in the form of the scholar. Even our poetic arts have had to develop out of scholarly imitations, and in the important effect of rhyme we recognize still the development of our poetical form out of artificial experiments with what is essentially a really scholarly language, not one native to us. To a true Greek how incomprehensible Faust would have to have appeared, the man of modern culture, inherently intelligible to us, who storms dissatisfied through all faculties, that Faust whose drive for knowledge makes him devoted to magic and the devil. We have only to stand him beside Socrates for comparison in order to recognize that modern man is beginning to have a premonition of the limits of that Socratic desire for knowledge and is yearning for a coastline in the wide, desolate sea of knowledge. When Goethe once remarked to Eckermann, with reference to Napoleon, "Yes, my good man, there is also a productivity in actions," in a delightfully naive way he was reminding us that the non-theoretical man is something implausible and astonishing to modern human beings, so that, once again, it required the wisdom of a Goethe to find out that such a strange form of existence is comprehensible, indeed, forgivable. And now we should not conceal from ourselves what lies hidden in the womb of this Socratic culture! An optimism that thinks itself all-powerful! Well, people should not be surprised

when the fruits of this optimism ripen, when a society that has been thoroughly leavened with this kind of culture, right down to the lowest levels, gradually trembles with an extravagant turmoil of desires, when the belief in earthly happiness for everyone, when faith in the possibility of such a universal knowledge culture gradually changes into the threatening demand for such an Alexandrian earthly happiness, into the plea for a Euripidean *deus ex machina*! People should take note: Alexandrian culture requires a slave class in order to be able to exist over time, but with its optimistic view of existence, it denies the necessity for such a class and thus, when the effect of its beautiful words of seduction and reassurance about the “dignity of human beings” and the “dignity of work” has worn off, it gradually moves towards a horrific destruction. There is nothing more frightening than a barbarian slave class which has learned to think of its existence as an injustice and is preparing to take revenge, not only for itself, but for all generations. In the face of such threatening storms, who dares appeal with sure confidence to our pale and exhausted religions, which themselves in their foundations have degenerated into scholarly religions, so that myth, the essential pre-condition for every religion, is already paralyzed everywhere, and even in this area that optimistic spirit which we have just described as the germ of destruction of our society has gained control. While the disaster slumbering in the bosom of theoretical culture gradually begins to worry modern man, while he, in his uneasiness, reaches into the treasure of his experience for ways to avert the danger, without himself having any real faith in these means, and while he also begins to have a premonition of the particular consequences for him, some great wide-ranging natures have, with an incredible circumspection, known how to use the equipment of science itself to set out the boundaries and restricted nature of knowledge generally and, in the process, decisively to deny the claim of science to universal validity and universal goals. Given proofs like this, the delusion which claims that with the help of causality it can fathom the innermost essence of things has for the first time become recognized for what it is. The immense courage and wisdom of Kant and Schopenhauer achieved the most difficult victory, the victory over the optimism lying concealed in the essential nature of logic, which is, in turn, the foundation of our culture. While this logic, based on *aeternae veritates* [eternal truths] which it did not consider open to objection, believed that all the riddles of the world could be recognized and resolved and had treated space, time, and causality as totally unconditional laws with the most universal validity, Kant showed how these really served only to raise mere appearance, the work of Maja, to the single, highest reality and to set it in place of the innermost and true essence of things and thus to make true knowledge of this essence impossible, that is, in the words of Schopenhauer, to get the dreamer to sleep even more soundly World as Will and Idea, I, 498). With this recognition there is introduced a culture which I

venture to describe as a tragic culture. Its most important distinguishing feature is that wisdom replaces science as the highest goal, a wisdom which, undeceived by the seductive diversions of science, turns its unswerving gaze onto the all-encompassing picture of the world and, with a sympathetic feeling of love, seeks in that world to grasp eternal suffering as its own suffering. Let us picture for ourselves a generation growing up with this fearlessness in its gaze, with this heroic push into what is tremendous; let us picture for ourselves the bold stride of these dragon slayers, the proud audacity with which they turn their backs on all the doctrines of weakness associated with that optimism, in order “to live with resolution,” fully and completely. Would it not be necessary that the tragic man of this culture, having trained himself for what is serious and frightening, desire a new art, the art of metaphysical consolation, the tragedy, as his own personal Helen of Troy, and to have to cry out with Faust: With my desire’s power, should I not call Into this life the fairest form of all? However, now that Socratic culture has been shaken on two sides and can hang onto the sceptre of its infallibility only with trembling hands, first of all by the fear of its own consequences, which it is definitely beginning to sense and, in addition, because it is itself no longer convinced with that earlier naive trust of the eternal validity of its foundations, it’s a sorry spectacle how the dance of its thinking constantly dashes longingly after new forms in order to embrace them and then how, like Mephistopheles with the seductive Lamias, it suddenly, with a shudder, lets them go again.⁽⁷⁰⁾ That is, in fact, the characteristic mark of that “fracture” which everyone is in the habit of talking about as the root malady of modern culture, that theoretical man is afraid of his own consequences and, in his dissatisfaction, no longer dares to commit himself to the fearful ice currents of existence. He runs anxiously up and down along the shore. He no longer wants to have anything completely, any totality with all the natural cruelty of things. That’s how much the optimistic way of seeing things has mollicoddled him. At the same time he feels how a culture which has been built on the principle of science must collapse when it begins to become illogical, that is, when it begins to run back once it is faced with its own consequences. Our art reveals this general distress: in vain people use imitation to lean on all the great productive periods and natures; in vain they gather all “world literature” around modern man to bring him consolation and place him in the middle of artistic styles and artists of all ages, so that he may, like Adam with the animals, give them a name. But he remains an eternally hungry man, the “critic” without joy and power, the Alexandrian man, who is basically a librarian and copy editor and goes miserably blind from the dust of books and printing errors. ¹⁹ We can designate the innermost meaning of this Socratic culture no more precisely than when we call it the culture of opera, for in this area this Socratic culture, with characteristic naïveté, has expressed its wishes and perceptions, something astonishing to us, if we bring the genesis of opera and the

facts of the development of opera together with the eternal truths of the Apollonian and the Dionysian. First, I bring to mind the emergence of the *stilo rappresentativo* [the representational style] and of recitative. Is it credible that this entirely externalized opera music, something incapable of worship, could be accepted and preserved with wildly enthusiastic favour, as if it were the rebirth of all true music, during an age in which Palestrina's inexpressibly awe-inspiring and sacred music had just arisen?(71) On the other hand, who would make the diversion-loving voluptuousness of those Florentine circles or the vanity of its dramatic singers responsible for such an impetuously spreading love of opera? The fact that in the same age—indeed, in the same peoples—alongside the vaulted structure of Palestrina's harmonies, which the entire Christian Middle Ages had developed, there awoke that passion for a half-musical way of speaking—that I can explain only by some (T)tendency beyond art(T) at work in the very nature of recitative. To the listener who wishes to hear clearly the word under the singing, there corresponds the singer who speaks more than he sings and who intensifies the expressions of pathos in this half-singing. Through this intensification of pathos he makes the words easier to understand and overpowers that part of the music which remains. The real danger now threatening him is that at an inopportune moment he may give the music the major emphasis, so that the pathos in the speech and the clarity of the words necessarily disappear at once. On the other hand, he always feels the urge for musical release and a virtuoso presentation of his voice. Here the “poet” comes to his assistance, the man who knows how to provide him sufficient opportunities for lyrical interjections, repetitions of words and sentences, and so on, places where the singer can now rest in the purely musical element, without considering the words. This alternation of urgently emotional speech which is only half sung and interjections which are all singing, which lies at the heart of the *stilo rappresentativo*, this rapidly changing effort at one moment to affect the understanding and imagination of the listener and, at another, to work on his musical sensibility, is something so completely unnatural and similarly so inwardly contradictory to the Dionysian and Apollonian artistic drives that we must infer an origin of recitative which lies outside all artistic instincts. According to this account, we can define recitative as the mixing of epic and lyric performing, and, to be precise, not at all in an inwardly consistent blending, which could not have been attained with such entirely disparate things, but in the most external conglutination, in the style of a mosaic, something the like of which has no model whatsoever in the realm of nature and experience. But this was not the opinion of those inventors of recitative. By contrast, they themselves, along with their age, believed that through that *stilo rappresentativo* the secret of ancient music had been resolved, that only through it could one explain the tremendous effect of an Orpheus, Amphion, indeed, even of Greek tragedy.(72)

The new style was valued as the reawakening of the most effective music, the music of the ancient Greeks; in fact, under the universal and totally popular conception of the Homeric world as the primitive world, people could abandon themselves to the dream that they had now climbed down once more into the paradisaal beginnings of humankind, in which music must necessarily have had that superb purity, power, and innocence which the poets knew how to talk about so movingly in their pastoral plays. Here we see into the innermost development of this truly genuine modern style of art, the opera: a powerful need forcibly creates an art, but it is a need of an unaesthetic sort, the yearning for the idyllic, the belief in a primordial existence of the artistic and good man. Recitative served as the rediscovered language of that primordial man, and opera as the rediscovered land of that idyllic or heroically good being, who at the same time follows a natural artistic drive in all his actions, who sings at least something in everything he has to say, so that, given the slightest emotional arousal, he immediately sings out in full voice. For us now it is unimportant that contemporary humanists used this newly created picture of the paradisaal artist to fight against the old church idea of human beings as inherently corrupt and lost, so that opera is to be understood as the opposing dogma of good people, something with which they simultaneously discovered a way of consoling themselves against that pessimism to which the serious-minded people of that time, given the horrifying uncertainties of all social conditions, were attracted most strongly. It's enough for us to recognize how the real magic and thus the origin of this new artistic form lies in the satisfaction of an entirely unaesthetic need, in the optimistic glorification of man as such, in its view of primitive man as a naturally good and artistic man. This operatic principle has gradually transformed itself into a threatening and terrible demand, which we, faced with the socialist movement of the present day, can no longer fail to hear. The "good primitive man" wants his rights: what paradisaal prospects! Alongside this point I set still another equally clear confirmation of my view that opera is constructed on the same principles as our Alexandrian culture. Opera is the offspring of the theoretical man, of the critical layman, not of the artist—one of the strangest facts in the history of all the arts. It was the demand of essentially unmusical listeners that people had to understand the words above all, so that a rebirth of music was only to be expected when some way of singing was discovered according to which the words of the text rule over the counterpoint the way a lord rules over his servants. For the words, they claimed, are much nobler than the accompanying harmonic system, just as the soul is much nobler than the body. In the beginning of opera, the union of music, image, and word was treated according to the amateurish, unmusical crudity of these views. The first experiments with the meaning of this aesthetic were launched even in distinguished amateur circles in Florence by the poets and singers patronized

there. The man who is artistically impotent produces for himself a form of art precisely because he is the inherently inartistic man. Because he has no sense of the Dionysian depths of music, for his own sake he transforms musical taste into easy-to-understand verbal and musical rhetoric of the passions in the stilo rappresentativo and into the voluptuousness of the art of singing; because he is incapable of seeing a vision, he presses mechanics and decorative artists into his service; because he has no idea how to grasp the true essence of the artist, he conjures up in front of him the “artistic primitive man” to suit his own taste, that is, the man who, when passionate, sings and speaks verse. He dreams himself back in an age in which passion was sufficient to produce songs and poems, as if every feeling is capable of creating something artistic. The precondition of opera is a false belief about the artistic process; more precisely, it is that idyllic faith that in reality every sensitive man is an artist. In keeping with the sense of this belief, opera is the expression of lay amateurs in art, something which dictates its laws with the cheerful optimism of the theoretical man. If we wanted to bring together into a single conception both of these ideas I have just described, which were at work in the origin of opera, all we would have left to do is to speak of an idyllic tendency in opera, and for that the only thing we would need to use is Schiller’s way of expressing himself and his explanation. He claimed that nature and the ideal are either an object of sorrow, when the former is represented as lost and the latter as unattained, or both are an object of joy, when they are represented as real. The first produces the elegy in a narrower sense, and the other produces the idyll in its broadest sense. Now we can immediately draw attention here to the common characteristic of both of those ideas in the genesis of opera, that in them the ideal does not register as unattained, and nature does not register as lost. According to this feeling, there was a primordial time for man when he lay on the heart of nature and, in this state of nature, at the same time attained the ideal of humanity in paradisaal goodness and artistry. We all are said to have descended from these perfect primitive men; indeed, we still were their faithful image; we only had to cast some things away from us in order to recognize ourselves once again as these primitive people, thanks to a voluntary renunciation of superfluous scholarship, of lavish culture. Through his operatic imitation of Greek tragedy, the educated man of the Renaissance let himself be led back to such a harmony of nature and the ideal, to an idyllic reality. He used this tragedy, as Dante used Virgil, in order to be led right up to the gates of paradise, while from this point on he strode even further on his own and passed over from an imitation of the highest Greek art form to a “restoration of all things,” to a replica of man’s original artistic world.(73) What a confident good nature there is in these audacious attempts, right in the bosom of theoretical culture! Something to be explained only by the comforting faith that “the essential man” is the eternally virtuous hero of opera, the eternally piping or

singing shepherd, who must always in the end rediscover himself as such, should he find out at some time or other that he has really lost himself for a while: the only fruit of that optimism which here arises out of the depths of the Socratic world view, like a sweetly seductive fragrant column of air. Hence, among the characteristics of opera there is no sense at all of that elegiac pain of an eternal loss; instead there is the cheerfulness of eternal rediscovery, the comfortable joy in an idyllic reality, the truth of which man can at least imagine for himself in every moment. In doing this, man may perhaps at some point suspect that this imagined reality is nothing other than a fantastically silly indulgence, at which anyone able to measure it against the fearful seriousness of true nature and to compare it with the actual primitive scenes of the beginnings of humanity would have to cry out in disgust: Get rid of that phantom! Nevertheless, we would be deceiving ourselves if we believed that such a flirtatious being as opera could be frightened off simply by a powerful shout, like a ghost. Whoever wants to destroy opera must undertake the struggle against that Alexandrine cheerfulness, which expresses its favourite idea so naively in opera; in fact, opera is its real artistic form. But what can we expect for art itself from the effect of a form of art whose origins do not lie in the aesthetic realm at all but which have, by contrast, stolen from a half moralistic sphere over into the sphere of art and which can deceive people about this hybrid origin only now and then? On what juices does this parasitic operatic being feed itself, if not from the sap of true art? Are we not to assume that, among opera's idyllic seductions, among its Alexandrine arts of flattering, the highest task of art, the one we should truly call serious—saving the eye from a glimpse into the horror of the night and through the healing balm of illusion rescuing the subject from the spasms brought about by the stirring of the will—would degenerate into a tendency to empty and scattered diversion? What becomes of the eternal truths of the Dionysian and the Apollonian in such a mixture of styles of the sort I have set down as the essence of the *stilo rappresentativo*, where the music is considered the servant and the libretto the master, where the music is compared to the body and the libretto to the soul, where the highest goal at best will aim at a descriptive tone painting, as it was earlier with the new Attic dithyramb, where the music is completely alienated from its true dignity, which is to be a Dionysian world-mirror, so that the only thing left for it is to imitate the essential forms of appearances, like a slave of phenomena, and to arouse a superficial entertainment in the play of lines and proportions? A rigorous examination shows how this fatal influence of opera on music coincides precisely with the entire modern development of music; the optimism lurking in the genesis of opera and in the essence of the culture represented through opera has succeeded with alarming speed in stripping music of its Dionysian world meaning and stamping on it a formally playful, amusing character. This transformation can be compared only to something like the

metamorphosis of Aeschylean man into the Alexandrian cheerful man. However, if in the explanation given above we have been right to link the disappearance of the Dionysian spirit with an extremely striking but so far unexplained transformation and degeneration of Greek man, what hopes must revive in us when the surest favourable signs bring us the guarantee of the reverse process, of the gradual awakening of the Dionysian spirit in our contemporary world! It is not possible that the divine power of Hercules should remain always impotent in voluptuous bondage to Omphale.(74) Out of the Dionysian foundation of the German spirit a power has arisen which has nothing in common with the most fundamental assumptions of Socratic culture, something which those assumptions can neither explain nor excuse, but which instead is experienced by this culture as something frightening, inexplicable, as overpowering and hostile—that is, German music, above all as we must understand it in its mighty solar orbit from Bach to Beethoven, from Beethoven to Wagner. Even in the best of circumstances what can the Socratism of our day, greedy for knowledge, begin to make of this daemon rising out of the inexhaustible depths? Neither from the lacework or arabesques of operatic melodies nor with the help of the arithmetical abacus of fugue and contrapuntal dialectic will a formula reveal itself in whose triple-powered light people can render that daemon obsequious and compel it to speak. What a spectacle when our aestheticians nowadays, with the hunting net of “beauty” all their own, strike at and try to catch that musical genius romping around in front of them with incredible life, with movements which will not be judged according to standards of eternal beauty any more than of the sublime. We should inspect these patrons of music for a moment, in person and at close quarters, when they cry out so tirelessly “Beauty! Beauty!” to see whether, in the process, they look like discriminating darling children of nature educated in the lap of beauty or whether they are not, by contrast, seeking a deceptively euphemistic form for their own crudity, an aesthetic pretext for their characteristically unfeeling sobriety. Here, for example, I’m thinking of Otto Jahn.(75) But the liar and hypocrite should beware of German music, for in the midst of all our culture it is precisely the one unalloyed, pure, and purifying fire spirit out from which and towards which all things move in a double orbit, as in the doctrine of the great Heraclitus of Ephesus: everything which we now call culture, education, civilization must at some point appear before the unerring judge Dionysus.(76) Furthermore, let’s remember how the spirit of German philosophy in Kant and Schopenhauer, streaming from the same springs, was able to annihilate the contented joy in existence of scientific Socratism by demonstrating its boundaries, how with this demonstration an infinitely deeper and more serious consideration of ethical questions and of art was introduced, which we can truly describe as Dionysian wisdom conceptually understood. Where does the mystery of this unity between German music and German

philosophy point if not to a new form of existence, about whose meaning we can inform ourselves only by speculating on the basis of analogies with the Greeks? For the Greek model has this immeasurable value for us who stand on the border line between two different forms of existence—in it are also stamped all those transitions and struggles in a classically instructive form, except that, to use an analogy, we are, as it were, living through the great high ages of Greek being in the reverse order: for example, we seem to be moving now out of an Alexandrian period backwards into a period of tragedy. At the same time, we feel as if the birth of a tragic time period for the German spirit only means a return to itself, a blessed re-discovery of self, after hugely invasive forces from outside had for a long time forced it into servitude under their form, that spirit which, so far as form is concerned, had lived in helpless barbarism. And now finally, after its return home to the original spring of its being, it can dare to stride in here before all peoples, bold and free, without the guiding reins of a Romanesque civilization. If only it can now understand how to keep learning continuously from a single people, the Greeks; being at all capable of learning from them is already a high honour and a remarkable distinction. And when have we needed these most eminent of mentors more than now, when we are experiencing the rebirth of tragedy and are in danger of not knowing where it is coming from and of being incapable of interpreting where it wants to go? 20 At some point under the eyes of an incorruptible judge we may determine in what age and in which men up to now the German spirit has struggled most powerfully to learn from the Greeks, and if we can assume with confidence that this extraordinary praise must be awarded to the noblest cultural struggles of Goethe, Schiller, and Winckelmann, then we would certainly have to add that, since that time and the most recent developments of that battle, the attempt to attain a culture and to reach the Greeks by the same route has become incomprehensibly weaker and weaker.(77) In order to avoid being forced into total despair about the German spirit, should we not conclude from all this that in some important point or other even those fighters could not succeed in penetrating into the core of the Hellenic spirit and creating a lasting bond of love between German and Greek culture? Perhaps an unconscious recognition of this failure even gives rise in more serious natures to the enervating doubt whether, after such predecessors, they could go even further than those men had along this cultural path and reach their goal at all. For that reason since that time we've seen the judgment about the cultural value of the Greeks degenerate in the most disturbing way. We can hear expressions of sympathetic condescension in the most varied encampments of the spirit and of the lack of spirit [des Geistes und des Ungeistes]. In other places a completely ineffectual sweet talk flirts with "Greek harmony," "Greek beauty," and "Greek cheerfulness." And precisely in the circles which could dignify themselves by drawing tirelessly from the Greek river bed in order to benefit

German culture—in the circles of teachers in the institutes of higher education—people have learned best to come to terms with the Greeks early and in a comfortable manner, not rarely to the point of sceptically abandoning the Hellenic ideal and totally reversing the real purpose of classical studies. In general, anyone in those circles who has not completely exhausted himself in the effort to be a dependable corrector of old texts or a microscopic studier of language, like some natural historian, may perhaps even seek to acquire Greek antiquity “historically,” alongside other antiquities, but in any case following the methods of our present academic historical writing, along with its supercilious expressions. If, as a result, the real cultural power of the institutions of higher learning has certainly never before been lower and weaker than at present, if the “journalist,” the paper slave of the day, has won his victory over the professors in every respect, so far as culture is concerned, and the only thing still left for the latter is the by-now frequently experienced metamorphosis which has them also moving around these days, to speak in the style of a journalist, with the “light elegance” of this sphere, like cheerful, well-educated butterflies, then how awkward and confusing it must be for those educated in this manner and living in such a present to stare at something which may be understood only by an analogy to the most profound principles of the as yet unintelligible Hellenic genius, the revival of the Dionysian spirit and the rebirth of tragedy. There is no other artistic period in which so-called culture and true art have stood more alienated from and averse to each other than what we witness with our own eyes nowadays. We understand why such a weak culture despises true art, for it fears such art will destroy it. But surely after being able to taper off into such a delicate and slight point as our contemporary culture, a complete cultural style, that is, the Socratic-Alexandrian, must have run its full life. When heroes like Schiller and Goethe could not succeed in breaking down that enchanted door which leads to the Hellenic magic mountain, when for all their most courageous struggles they reached no further than that yearning gaze which Goethe’s Iphigeneia sent from barbaric Tauris over the sea towards her home, what is left for the imitators of such heroes to hope for, unless from some totally different side, untouched by all the efforts of previous culture, the door might suddenly open for them on its own—to the accompaniment of the mysterious sound of the reawakened music of tragedy? Let no one try to detract from our belief in a still imminent rebirth of Hellenic antiquity, for that is the only place where we find our hope for a renewal and reformation of the German spirit through the fiery magic of music. What would we otherwise know to name which amid the desolation and weariness of contemporary culture could awaken some comforting expectation for the future? We peer in vain for a single, powerful, branching root, for a spot of fertile and healthy soil: everywhere dust, sand, ossification, decay. Here a desperate, isolated man could not choose a better

symbol than the knight with Death and the Devil, as Dürer has drawn him for us, the knight in armour with the hard iron gaze, who knows how to make his way along his terrible path, without being dismayed at his horrific companions, and yet without any hope, alone with his horse and hound. Such a Dürer knight was our Schopenhauer: he lacked all hope, but he wanted the truth. There is no one like him.(78) But how suddenly that wilderness of our exhausted culture I have just so gloomily sketched out changes when the Dionysian magic touches it! A tempest seizes everything worn out, rotten, broken apart, and stunted, wraps it in a red whirling cloud of dust, and, like a vulture, lifts it up into the air. In our bewilderment, our eyes seek out what has disappeared, for what they see has risen up, as if from oblivion, into golden light, so full and green, so richly alive, so immeasurable and full of longing. Tragedy sits in the midst of this superfluity of life, suffering, and joy; with awe-inspiring delight it listens to a distant melancholy song, which tells of the mothers of being whose names sound out: Delusion, Will, Woe. Yes, my friends, believe with me in the Dionysian life and in the rebirth of tragedy. The age of the Socratic man is over: crown yourselves with ivy, take the thyrsus stalk in your hand, and don't be amazed when tigers and panthers lie down fawning at your feet. Only now you must dare to be tragic men, for you are to be redeemed. You are to lead the Dionysian celebratory procession from India to Greece! Arm yourselves for a hard battle, but have faith in the miracles of your god! 21 Moving back from this tone of exhortation into a mood suitable for contemplation, I repeat that only from the Greeks can we learn what such a miraculously sudden awakening of tragedy can mean for the innermost, fundamental life of a populace. It is the people of the tragic mysteries who fight the Persian wars, and then, in turn, the people who carried on these wars use tragedy as an essential potion in their recovery.(79) Who would have suspected that these particular people, after being stirred right to their innermost being for several generations by the strongest paroxysms of the Dionysian daemon, still had such a regular and powerful outpouring of the simplest political feeling, the most natural instinctive emotion for their homeland, the original manly desire to fight? Nonetheless, if we always sense in every remarkable Dionysian arousal which takes hold of its surroundings how Dionysian release from the shackles of individuality registers at first as a heightened restriction of the political instinct, all the way to indifference and even hostility, it is also true that, on the other hand, Apollo, the nation builder, is also the genius of the principium individuationis and that a sense of state and homeland cannot survive without an affirmation of the individual personality. From orgiastic experience there is only one way out for a people, the route to Indian Buddhism, which, with its longing for nothingness, in order to be endurable, generally requires those rare ecstatic states with their ascent above space, time, and individuality, just as these states, in their turn, demand a philosophy which teaches people to use some idea

to overcome the unimaginable dreariness of intermediate states. In cases where the political drives are considered absolutely valid, it's equally necessary for a people to turn to a path of the most extreme secularization. The most magnificent but also the most terrifying example of this is the Roman empire. Standing between India and Rome and forced to make a tempting choice, the Greeks succeeded in inventing a third form in classical purity. Of course, they did not make use of it for long themselves, but for that very reason they made it immortal. The fact that the darlings of the gods die early holds in all things, but it's equally certain that then they live among the gods forever. So people should not demand from the noblest thing of all that it should possess the hard-wearing durability of leather; that crude toughness characteristic of the Roman national impulses, for example, probably does not belong to the necessary predicates of perfection. But if we ask what remedies made it possible for the Greek in their great period, with the extraordinary strength of their Dionysian and political drives, not to exhaust themselves either with an ecstatic brooding or in a consuming pursuit of world power and worldly honour, but to reach that marvellous mixture—just as a noble wine makes one feel fiery and meditative at the same time—then we must keep in mind the immense power of tragedy, which stimulated the entire life of the people, purifying it and giving it release. We will first sense its highest value when, as with the Greeks, it confronts us as the essence of all prophylactic healing potions, as the mediator adjudicating between the strongest and inherently most disastrous characteristics of a people. Tragedy draws the highest musical ecstasy into itself, so that, with the Greeks, as with us, it immediately brings music to its culmination. But then it places the tragic myth and the tragic hero next to the music, and he then, like a powerful Titan, takes the whole Dionysian world on his back and thus relieves us of it. On the other hand, with the same tragic myth, in the person of the tragic hero, tragedy knows how to redeem us from the greedy pressure for this existence and with a warning hand reminds us of another state of being and a higher pleasure for which the struggling hero, filled with foreboding, is preparing himself, not through his victory, but through his destruction. Tragedy places between the universal validity of its music and the listener sensitive to the Dionysian an awe-inspiring parable—the myth—and with that awakens an illusion, as if the music is only the production's highest device for bringing life to the plastic world of the myth. Trusting in this noble deception, tragedy can now move its limbs in the dithyrambic dance and abandon itself unconsciously to an ecstatic feeling of freedom; without that deception it would not dare to revel in the very essence of music. The myth protects us from the music, while it, by contrast, immediately gives the music its highest freedom. In return, the music gives back to the tragic myth, as a return gift, an urgent and convincing metaphysical significance, of a kind which word and image could never attain without that unique assistance,

and through the music, in particular, there comes over the spectator of tragedy that certain presentiment of the highest joy, the road to which leads through destruction and negation, so that he thinks what he hears is like the innermost abyss of things speaking to him out loud. If in these last sentences I have perhaps been able to provide only a provisional expression of this difficult idea, something immediately understandable to few people, at this particular point I cannot refrain from urging my friends to a further attempt and from asking them with a single example of our common experience to prepare themselves to recognize a general principle. With this example, I am not referring to those who use the images of the action in the scene, the words and emotions of those doing the acting, so that with this help they can come closer to the feeling of the music, for none of these people speaks music as a mother tongue, and, for all that help, they proceed no further than the lobbies of musical perception, without ever being entitled to touch its innermost shrine. Some of these who take this road, like Gervinus, do not even succeed in reaching the lobby.(80) No, I must turn only to those who have an immediate relationship with music, who find in it, as it were, their mother's womb and stand bound up with things almost exclusively through an unconscious musical relationship. To these true musicians I direct the question: Can they imagine a person capable of perceiving the third act of *Tristan and Isolde* purely as an immense symphonic movement, getting no help from words and images, without suffocating from a convulsive spreading of all the wings of the soul?(81) A man who, as in this case, has set his ear, so to speak, on the heart chambers of the world's will, who feels in himself the raging desire for existence pouring forth into all the veins of the world as a thundering rainstorm or as the most delicately spraying brook—would such a man not fall apart on the spot? Could he endure hearing in the suffering glass case of his human individuality the echo of countless cries of desire and woe from the “wide space of the world's night,” without, in the midst of this shepherd's medley of metaphysics, inexorably flying off for refuge to his primordial home? But what if nonetheless such a work can be perceived as a totality, without the denial of individual existence, what if such a creation could be produced without shattering its creator—where do we get the solution to such a contradiction? Here, between our highest musical excitement and that music, the tragic myth and the tragic hero interpose themselves, basically only as a metaphor for the most universal facts of all, about which only music can speak directly. However, if we felt as purely Dionysian beings, then myth would be entirely ineffectual as a metaphor and would remain beside us unnoticed. It would not make us turn our ears away for an instant from listening to the echo of the *universalia ante rem* [the universal before the fact]. But here the Apollonian power breaks through, preparing for the reintegration of the almost shattered individuality with the healing balm of a blissful illusion. Suddenly we think we still see only *Tristan*,

motionless and dazed, as he asks himself, "The old melody, what does it awaken for me?" And what earlier struck us as an empty sigh from the centre of being now only wishes to say to us something like "the barren, empty sea." And where we breathlessly imagined we were dying in a convulsive inner paroxysm of all our feelings with only a little linking us to this existence, now we hear and see only the hero mortally wounded and yet not dying, with his cry full of despair, "Longing! Longing! In death still yearning, and not to die for very longing." And when earlier, after such an excess and such a huge number of consuming torments, the jubilation of the horns, almost like the highest agony, cuts through our hearts, there stands between us and this "jubilation in itself" the celebrating Kurwenal, turned towards the ship which carries Isolde. No matter how powerful the pity gripping us inside, this pity nonetheless saves us, in a certain sense, from the primordial suffering of the world, just as the symbolic picture of the myth saves us from the immediate look at the highest world idea, just as the idea and the word save us from the unrestrained outpouring of the unconscious will. Because of that marvelous Apollonian deception it seems to us as if the empire of music itself confronted us as a plastic world, as if in it only Tristan's and Isolde's destiny had been formed and stamped out in pictures, as in the most delicate and expressive of all material. Thus the Apollonian rescues us from Dionysian universality and delights us with individuals. It attaches our aroused feelings of sympathy to them, and with them it satisfies our sense of beauty, which longs for great and awe-inspiring forms; it parades images of life before us and provokes us to a thoughtful grasp of the kernel of life contained in them. With the immense power of image, idea, ethical instruction, and sympathetic arousal, the Apollonian lifts man up out of his ecstatic self-destruction and blinds him to the universality of the Dionysian process, leading him to the delusion that he is watching just one image of the world—for example, Tristan and Isolde—and that through the music he is only supposed to see it even better and more inwardly. What can the healing magic of Apollo not achieve, if it can even arouse in us this delusion, so that it seems as if the Dionysian is really working to serve the Apollonian and is capable of intensifying its effects—in fact, as if the music were even essentially an artistic presentation of an Apollonian content? With that pre-established harmony which reigns between the perfect drama and its music, drama attains a supreme degree of vividness, something which verbal drama otherwise could not approach. As in the independently moving melodic lines all the living forms in the scene simplify themselves in front of us into the clarity of curved lines, the juxtaposition of these lines sounds out to us in the harmonic changes which sympathize in the most delicate way with the action as it moves forward. While this happens, the relation of things becomes immediately perceptible to us in a more sensuously perceptible way, which has nothing abstract about it at all, as we also recognize through it that only in these relations

does the essence of a character and of a melodic line clearly reveal itself. And while the music compels us in this way to see more and more profoundly than ever and the scenic action spreads itself in front of us like a delicate spider's web, for our spiritual inward-gazing eye the world of the stage is just as infinitely widened as it is illuminated from within. What could a word poet offer analogous to this—someone who struggles with a very imperfect mechanism in indirect ways to attain with word and idea that inner expansion of the vivid world of the stage and its inner illumination? Musical tragedy, of course, also uses the word, but at the same time it can set beside it the fundamental basis and birth place of the word and reveal to us from inside what that word has become. But nonetheless we could just as surely claim about this depiction of the action that it is only a marvellous appearance, i.e., that previously mentioned Apollonian illusion, through whose effect we are to be relieved of the Dionysian surge and excess. In fact, the relationship between music and drama is fundamentally the very reverse—the music is the essential idea of the world, the drama only a reflection of this idea, an isolated silhouette. That identity between the melodic line and the living form, between the harmony and the relations of the characters in that form, is true in a sense opposite to what it might seem to be for us as we look at musical tragedy. We may well stir up the form in the most visible way, enliven and illuminate it from within, but it always remains only an appearance, from which there is no bridge leading to true reality, into the heart of the world. But music speaks out from this heart, and although countless appearances of that sort could clothe themselves in the same music, they would never exhaust its essence, but would always be only its external reflection. Of course, for the complex relationship between music and drama nothing is explained and everything is confused by the popular and entirely false contrast between the soul and the body. But particularly among our aestheticians it's the unphilosophical crudity of that contrast which seems to have become, who knows the reasons why, quite a well-known article of faith, while they have learned nothing about the difference between the appearance and the thing-in-itself or, for similarly unknown reasons, don't want to learn anything. If one result of our analysis might be that the Apollonian in tragedy, thanks to its deception, emerges completely victorious over the Dionysian primordial element of music and makes use of this for its own purposes, that is, for the highest dramatic clarity, a very important reservation would naturally follow: at the most essential point that Apollonian deception is broken up and destroyed. The drama, which, with the help of music, spreads out in front of us with such inwardly illuminated clarity in all its movements and forms, as if we were seeing the fabric on the loom while the shuttle moves back and forth, achieves its effect as a totality which lies beyond all the artistic workings of the Apollonian. In the total effect of tragedy the Dionysian regains its superiority once more. Tragedy ends with a

tone which never could resound from the realm of Apollonian art. And as that happens, the Apollonian illusion reveals itself for what it is, as the veil which, so long as the tragedy is going on, has covered the essentially Dionysian effect. But this Dionysian effect is nonetheless so powerful that at the end it drives the Apollonian drama itself into a sphere where it begins to speak with Dionysian wisdom and where it denies itself and its Apollonian visibility. So we could truly symbolize the complex relationship between the Apollonian and the Dionysian in tragedy with the fraternal bond between both divinities: Dionysus speaks the language of Apollo, but Apollo finally speaks the language of Dionysus, and with that the highest goal of tragedy and art in general is attained. 22 An attentive friend should remind himself in a pure and unconfused manner, from his own experience, of a truly musical tragedy. I think I have described what this effect is like, attending to both aspects of it in such a way that he will now know how to interpret his own experience for himself. For he will recall how, confronted with the myth unfolding in front of him, he felt himself raised up to some sort of omniscience, as if now the visual power of his eyes was not merely a force dealing with surfaces but was capable of penetrating within, and as if, with the help of the music, he could now see in front of him the turbulent feelings of the will, the war of motives, the growing storm of passions as something which is, as it were, sensuously present, like an abundance of living lines and figures in motion, and thus as if he could plunge into the most delicate secrets of unknown emotions. As he becomes conscious of the highest intensification of his instincts which aim for clarity and transfiguration, nonetheless he feels with equal certainty that this long series of Apollonian artistic effects does not produce that delightful resignation of will-less contemplation which the sculptor and the epic poet—in other words, the genuine Apollonian artists—bring out in him with their works of art, that is, the justification of the world of the individual [individual]attained in that contemplation, which is the peak and essence of Apollonian art. He looks at the transfigured world of the stage and yet denies it. He sees the tragic hero in front of him in epic clarity and beauty and, nonetheless, takes pleasure in his destruction. He understands the events on stage to their innermost core and joyfully flies off into the incomprehensible. He feels the actions of the hero as justified and is, nonetheless, still more uplifted when these actions destroy the one who initiated them. He shudders in the face of the suffering which the hero is about to encounter and, nonetheless, because of it has a premonition of a higher, much more overpowering joy. He perceives more things and more profoundly than ever before and yet wishes he were blind. Where would we be able to derive this miraculous division of the self, this collapse of the Apollonian climax, if not from Dionysian magic, which, while it apparently excites the Apollonian feelings to their highest point, nevertheless can still force this exuberance of Apollonian art into its service? The tragic myth can

only be understood as a symbolic picture of Dionysian wisdom by means of Apollonian art. It leads the world of appearances to its limits, where it denies itself and once again seeks to fly back into the womb of the true and single reality, at which point it seems, with Isolde, to sing its metaphysical swan song. In the surging torrents of seas of my desires, in resounding tones of fragrant waves, in the blowing All of the world's breath—to drown, to sink down, to lose consciousness—the highest joy.(82) In this way we recall, from the experiences of the truly aesthetic listener, the tragic artist himself, as he, like a voluptuous divinity of individuationis [individuation], creates his forms, in which sense his work can scarcely be understood as an “imitation of nature”—but then as his immense Dionysian drive devours this entire world of appearances in order to allow us, through its destruction, to have a premonition behind it of the primal and highest artistic joy in the womb of the primordial One. Of course, our aestheticians don't know what to write about this return journey to our original home, about the fraternal bond of the two brother gods of art in tragedy, any more than they do about the Apollonian or the Dionysian excitement of the listener, while they never weary of characterizing as the essential feature of the tragic the struggle of the hero with fate, the victory of a moral world order, or the purging of the emotions achieved by tragedy. Such tireless efforts lead me to the thought that in general they may be men incapable of aesthetic excitement, so that when they hear a tragedy perhaps they think of themselves only as moral beings. Since Aristotle, there has not yet been an explanation of the tragic effect which could justify it on the basis of artistic conditions, of the aesthetic capability of the listener. Sometimes pity and fear are supposed to be pushed by the serious action to a discharge which brings relief. At other times, we are supposed to feel enthusiastic and elevated because of the victory of good and noble principles, by the sacrifice of the hero, taking that as a moral observation about the world. And just as I have no doubt that for countless men that and only that is precisely the effect of tragedy, so it is equally clear this reveals that all these people, along with their interpreting aestheticians, have experienced nothing of tragedy as a supreme art. That pathological purgation, the catharsis of Aristotle, which the philologists are uncertain whether to count a medical or a moral phenomenon, brings to mind a remarkable feeling of Goethe's: “Without a lively pathological interest,” he says, “I have also never succeeded in working on any kind of tragic situation, and therefore I have preferred to avoid it rather than seek it out. Could it perhaps be the case that among the merits of the ancients the highest degree of the pathetic was also only aesthetic play for them, while with us the truth of nature must be there as well, in order for such a work to be produced.” After our marvellous experiences we can now answer yes to this profound question, once we have experienced with wonder precisely this musical tragedy, how truly the highest degree of the pathetic can be, for all that, only an

aesthetic game. For that reason, we are entitled to think that only now can the primordial phenomenon of the tragic be described with some success. Anyone who nowadays still provides explanations only in terms of those surrogate effects from spheres beyond aesthetics and does not sense that he has risen above the pathological and moralistic processes may well despair altogether of his aesthetic nature. For that condition we recommend as an innocent substitute the interpretation of Shakespeare the way Gervinus does it and the diligent search for “poetic justice.” So with the rebirth of tragedy the aesthetic listener is also born again, in whose place up to this point a strange quid pro quo habitually sat in the theatre space, with half moral and half scholarly demands—the “critic.” In his sphere so far everything has been synthetic and merely whitewashed with the appearance of life. The performing artist, in fact, did not know any more what he could begin to do with such a listener who behaved critically, and therefore he, together with the dramatist or opera composer who inspired him, peered anxiously for the last remnants of life in this demanding, barren creature incapable of enjoying itself. But up to this point the general public has consisted of this sort of “critic.” Through education and the press, the student, the school child, indeed even the most harmless female creature has already been prepared, without being aware of it, to perceive a work of art in a similar manner. The more noble natures among the artists, faced with such a public, counted on exciting moral and religious forces, and the call for “a moral world view” stepped in vicariously, where, in fact, a powerful artistic magic should have entranced the real listener. Alternatively, dramatists brought out a splendid and at least exciting trend in contemporary political and social issues so vividly that the listener could forget his critical exhaustion and let himself go with feelings similar to those in patriotic or militaristic moments or in front of the speaker’s desk in parliament or in judicial sentences for crimes and vices. And that alienation from true artistic purposes necessarily led here and there directly to a culture of bias. But here there stepped in, what in all artificial arts up to now has intervened, a rapaciously quick loss of that very tendency, so that, for example, the view that the theatre should be used as an institution for the moral education of a people, something taken seriously in Schiller’s day, is already counted among the incredible antiquities of an education which has been superseded. As the critic came to rule in the theatre and concert, the journalist in the schools, and the press in society, art degenerated into an object of entertainment of the basest sort, and the aesthetic critic was used as a way of binding together a vain, scattered, selfish, and, beyond that, pitifully unoriginal social group, the meaning of which we can understand from that parable of the porcupines in Schopenhauer, so there has never been a time when people have chattered so much about art and thought so little of it.(83) But cannot we still associate with someone able to entertain himself with Beethoven and Shakespeare? Let everyone answer this question

according to his own feelings: with his answer he will at any rate demonstrate what he imagines by the word “culture,” provided he seeks to answer the question at all and has not already been struck dumb with astonishment. By contrast, many with a nobler and more naturally refined ability, even if they also have gradually turned into critical barbarians in the manner described above, could say something about an effect, as unexpected as it is entirely incomprehensible, of the sort which a work like a happily successful production of Lohengrin has had on them, except perhaps they lacked any hand which could assist them with advice and interpretation; thus, that incredibly different and totally incomparable sensation which so shook them at the time remained a single example and, after a short period of illumination, died out, like a mysterious star.⁽⁸⁴⁾ That was the moment they had a presentiment of what an aesthetic listener is. ²³ Anyone who wants an accurate test for himself to see how closely related he is to the truly aesthetic listener or how much he belongs with the Socratic-critical community could sincerely ask himself about the feeling with which he receives some miracle presented on stage. In that situation, for example, does he feel offended in his historical sense, which organizes itself on strict psychological causality, or does he, in a spirit of generosity, as it were, make a concession to the miracle as something comprehensible in childhood but foreign to him, or does he suffer anything else at all in that process? For in doing this he will be able to measure how far, in general, he is capable of understanding the myth, the concentrated world picture, which, as an abbreviation of appearance, cannot work without the miracle. However, it’s likely that almost everyone in a strict test would feel himself so thoroughly corrupted by the critical-historical spirit of our culture that he could make the previous existence of the myth credible only with something scholarly, with some mediating abstractions. But without myth every culture forfeits its healthy creative natural power: only a horizon surrounded with myth completes the unity of an entire cultural movement. Only through myth are all the powers of the imagination and of Apollonian dream rescued from their random wandering around. The images of myth must be the unseen, omnipresent, daemonic sentries under whose care the young soul matures and by whose signs a man interprets for himself his life and his struggles. Even the state knows no more powerful unwritten laws than the mythical foundation which guarantees its own connection to religion, its growth out of mythic ideas. Alongside that let us now place abstract people, those who are led around without myths, and abstract education, abstract customs, abstract law, the abstract state. Let us remember the disorderly roaming of the artistic imagination which is not restrained by any secret myth. Let us imagine a culture which has no fixed and sacred primordial seat but which is condemned to exhaust all possibilities and to subsist on a meager diet from all cultures—and there we have the present, the result of that Socratism whose aim

is to destroy myth. And now the man without myth stands there, eternally hungry, in the midst of all past ages, rummaging around and digging as he looks for roots, even if he has to shovel for them in the most remote ancient times. What is revealed in the immense historical need of this dissatisfied modern culture, the gathering up of countless other cultures, the consuming desire to know, if not the loss of myth, the loss of the mythic homeland, of the mythic maternal womb? Let us ask ourselves whether the feverish and strange agitation of this culture is something other than a starving man's greedy snatch-and-grab for food—and who would still want to give such a culture anything, when nothing which it gobbles down satisfies it and when, at its touch, the most powerful and healthiest nourishment habitually changes into “history and criticism”? We would even have to experience painful despair over our German being, if it were already inextricably intermixed in a similar way with its culture, or, indeed, if they had become a single unit, as we can observe, to our horror, with civilized France. What for a long time constituted the great merit of France and the cause of its huge superiority—that very unity of being in people and culture—should make us, when we look at it, praise our good luck that such a questionable culture as ours has had nothing in common up to this point with the noble core of our people's character. Instead of that, all our hopes are reaching out yearningly towards the awareness that under this restless cultural life and cultural convulsions twitching here and there lies hidden a glorious, innerly healthy, and age-old power, which naturally only begins to stir into powerful motion at tremendous moments and then goes on dreaming once again about a future awakening. Out of this abyss the German Reformation arose: in its choral music there rang out for the first time the future style of German music. This choral music of Luther's sounded as profound, courageous, and spiritual, as exuberantly good and tender, as the first Dionysian call rising up out of the thickly growing bushes at the approach of spring. In answer to it came the competing echo of that solemn exuberant procession of Dionysian throngs, whom we have to thank for German music—and whom we will thank for the rebirth of the German myth! I know that now I have to take the sympathetic friend who is following me up to a lofty place for lonely contemplation, where he will have only a few travelling companions. By way of encouragement I call out to him that we have to keep hold of those leaders who illuminate the way for us, the Greeks. Up to now, in order to purify our aesthetic awareness, we have borrowed from them both of those images of the gods, each of whom rules over his own specific artistic realm, and by considering Greek tragedy, we came to an awareness of their mutual contact and intensification. To us the downfall of Greek tragedy must appear to have occurred through a remarkable tearing apart of both of these primordial artistic drives, an event which was accompanied by a degeneration and transformation of the character of the Greek people, something

which demands from us some serious reflection about how necessarily and closely art and people, myth and custom, tragedy and the state are fundamentally intertwined. That downfall of tragedy was at the same time the downfall of myth. Up to that point the Greeks were instinctively compelled to tie everything they lived through immediately to their myths—in fact, to understand that experience only through this link. In that process, even the most recent present had to appear to them at once *sub specie aeterni* [under the eye of eternity] and thus, in a certain sense, to be timeless. In this stream of the timeless, however, the state and art both plunged equally, in order to find in it rest from the weight and greed of the moment. And a people—as well as a person, by the way—is only valuable to the extent that it can stamp upon its experiences the mark of the eternal, for in that way it is, as it were, relieved of the burden of the world and demonstrates its unconscious inner conviction of the relativity of time and of the true, that is, of the metaphysical meaning of life. Something quite different from this happens when a people begins to understand itself historically and to smash up the mythic bastions standing around it. Tied in with this development is usually a decisive secularization, a breach with the unconscious metaphysics of its earlier existence, along with all ethical consequences. Greek art and especially Greek tragedy above all checked the destruction of myth; people had to destroy them in order to be able to live detached from their home soil, unrestrained in a wilderness of thought, custom, and action. But now that metaphysical drive still tries to create, even if in a toned-down form, a transfiguration for itself, in the Socratism of science which pushes forward into life. But on the lower steps this very drive led only to a feverish search, which gradually lost itself in a pandemonium of myths and superstitions from all over the place, all piled up together, in the middle of which, nonetheless, the Hellene sat with an unquenched heart, until he understood to mask that fever with Greek cheerfulness and Greek negligence, in the form of *Graeculus*, or to plunge completely into some stupefying oriental superstition or other. In the most obvious way, since the reawakening of Alexandrian-Roman antiquity in the fifteenth century, after a long and difficult to describe interval, we have come closer to this condition. Up on the heights this same abundant desire for knowledge, the same insatiable happiness in discovery, the same immense secularization, alongside a homeless wandering around, a greedy thronging at foreign tables, a reckless idolizing of the present, or an apathetic, numbed turning away, with everything *sub specie saeculi* [under the eye of the secular], of the “present age”; these same symptoms lead us to suspect the same lack at the heart of this culture, the destruction of myth. It seems hardly possible that grafting on a foreign myth would have any lasting success, without in the process irreparably damaging the tree. Perhaps it is at some point strong and healthy enough to slice out that foreign element again with a dreadful struggle, but usually it must waste away, infirm and faded, or live on in a morbid

state. We have such a high regard for the pure and powerful core of the German being that we dare to expect from it, in particular, that elimination of powerfully grafted foreign elements and consider it possible that the German spirit will come back into an awareness of itself on its own. Perhaps some people will think that spirit would have to start its struggle with the elimination of the Romantic, and for that he could recognize an external preparation and encouragement in the victorious courage and bloody glory of the recent war. But the internal necessity must be sought in the competitive striving always to be worthy of the noble pioneers on this road, including Luther just as much as our great artists and poets. But let him never believe that he can fight similar battles without his house gods, without his mythic homeland, without a “bringing back” of all things German! And if the German in his hesitation should look around him for a leader who will take him back again to his long-lost homeland, whose roads and pathways he hardly knows any more—then let him only listen to the sweet, enticing call of the Dionysian bird hovering above him seeking to show him the way. 24 Among the characteristic artistic effects of musical tragedy we had to stress an Apollonian illusion through which we are to be rescued from immediate unity of being with the Dionysian music, while our musical excitement can discharge itself in an Apollonian sphere and in a visible middle world which interposed itself. By doing this we thought we had noticed how, simply through this discharge, that middle world of the scenic action, the drama in general, to a certain degree became visible and comprehensible from within, in a way which is unattainable in all other Apollonian art, so that here, where the Apollonian is energized and raised aloft, as it were, through the spirit of the music, we had to acknowledge the highest intensification of its power and, therefore, in that fraternal bond of Apollo and Dionysus the peak of both the Apollonian and the Dionysian artistic aims. Of course, the projected Apollonian image with this particular inner illumination through the music does not achieve the effect characteristic of the weaker degrees of Apollonian art, what epic or animated stone is capable of, compelling the contemplating eye to that calm delight in the world of the individual—in spite of a higher animation and clarity, that effect will not permit itself to be attained here. We looked at drama and with a penetrating gaze forced our way into the inner moving world of its motives—and nonetheless for us it was as if only an allegorical picture passed before us, whose most profound meaning we thought we could almost guess and which we wanted to pull aside, like a curtain, in order to look at the primordial image behind it. The brightest clarity of the image did not satisfy us, for this seemed to hide just as much as it revealed. And while, with its allegorical-like revelation, it seemed to promise to rip aside the veil, to disclose the mysterious background, once again it was precisely that penetrating light illuminating everything which held the eye in its spell and prevented it from probing more deeply. Anyone who has

not had this experience of having to watch and, at the same time, of yearning to go above and beyond watching will have difficulty imagining how definitely and clearly these two processes exist together and are felt alongside each other, as one observes the tragic myth. However, the truly aesthetic spectators will confirm for me that among the peculiar effects of tragedy that co-existence may be the most remarkable. If we now translate this phenomenon taking place in the aesthetic spectator into an analogous process in the tragic artist, we will have understood the genesis of the tragic myth. He shares with the Apollonian sphere of art the full joy in appearances and in watching—at the same time he denies this joy and has an even higher satisfaction in the destruction of the visible world of appearances. The content of the tragic myth is at first an epic event with the glorification of the struggling hero. But what is the origin of that inherently mysterious feature, the fact that the suffering in the fate of the hero, the most painful victories, the most agonizing opposition of motives, in short, the exemplification of that wisdom of Silenus, or, expressing it aesthetically, of the ugly and the dissonant, in so many countless forms, is presented with such fondness, always renewed, and precisely in the richest and most youthful age of a people, unless we recognize in all this a higher pleasure? For the fact that in life things are really so tragic would not in the least account for the development of an art form, if art is not only an imitation of natural reality but a metaphysical supplement to that reality, set beside it in order to overcome it. The tragic myth, insofar as it belongs to art at all, also participates fully in this general purpose of art to provide metaphysical transfiguration. But what does it transfigure, when it leads out the world of appearance in the image of the suffering hero? Least of all the “Reality” of this world of appearances, for it says directly to us: “Look here! Look right here! This is your life! This is the hour hand on the clock of your existence!” And did the myth show us this life in order to transfigure it in front of us? If not, in what does the aesthetic joy consist with which we allow those images to pass in front of us? I ask about aesthetic delight and know full well that many of these images can in addition now and then still produce a moral pleasure, for example, in the form of pity or a moral triumph. But whoever wants to derive the effect of the tragic merely from these moral origins, as, of course, has been customary in aesthetics for far too long, should not think that, in so doing, he has then done anything for art, which above all must demand purity in its realm. For an explanation of the tragic myth the very first demand is that he seek that joy characteristic of it in the purely aesthetic sphere, without reaching over into the territory of pity, fear, and the morally sublime. How can the ugly and dissonant, the content of the tragic myth, excite an aesthetic delight? Here it is necessary for us to vault with a bold leap into a metaphysics of art, when I repeat an earlier sentence—that existence and the world appear justified only as an aesthetic phenomenon. It is in this sense that the tragic myth has to convince

us that even the ugly and dissonant are an artistic game, which the will, in the eternal abundance of its joy, plays with itself. But there is a direct way to make this primordial phenomenon of Dionysian art, which is so difficult to comprehend, completely understandable and to enable one to grasp it immediately, through the miraculous meaning of musical dissonance, the way the music in general, set next to the world, is the only thing that can give an idea of what it means to understand a justification of the world as an aesthetic phenomenon. The joy which the tragic myth produces has the same homeland as the delightful sensation of dissonance in music. The Dionysian, together with its primordial joy felt even in pain, is the common birth womb of music and the tragic myth. Thus, is it not possible that we have made that difficult problem of the tragic effect really much easier now that we have called on the relation of musical dissonance to help us? For now we understand what it means in tragedy to want to keep looking and at the same time to yearn for something beyond what we see. We would have to characterize this condition in relation to the artistic use of dissonance simply as the fact that we want to keep listening and at the same time yearn to get beyond what we hear. That striving for the infinite, the wing beat of longing associated with the highest delight in clearly perceived reality, reminds us that in both states we must recognize a Dionysian phenomenon, which always reveals to us all over again the playful cracking apart and destruction of the world of the individual as the discharge of primordial delight, in a manner similar to the one in which gloomy Heraclitus compares the force constructing the world to a child who playfully sets stones here and there, builds sand piles, and then knocks them down again. And thus in order to assess the Dionysian capability of a people correctly, we have to think not just about their music; we must also think about their tragic myth as the second feature of that capacity. Given this closest of relationships between music and myth, now we can in a similar way assume that a degeneration and deprivation of one of them will be linked to a decline in the other, if in a weakening of myth generally a waning of the Dionysian capability really does manifest itself. But concerning both of these, a look at the development of the German being should leave us in no doubt: in the opera, as well as in the abstract character of our myth-deprived existence, in an art which has sunk down to entertainment, as well as in a life guided by concepts, that inartistic and equally life-draining nature of Socratic optimism stands revealed. For our consolation, however, there were indications that, in spite of everything, the German spirit rests and dreams in magnificent health, profundity, and Dionysian power, undamaged, like a knight sunk down in slumber in an inaccessible abyss. And from this abyss, the Dionysian song rises up to us in order to make us understand that this German knight is also still dreaming his age-old Dionysian myth in solemn, blissful visions. Let no one believe that the German spirit has lost forever its mythic homeland, when it still

understands so clearly the voices of the birds which tell of that homeland. One day it will find itself awake in all the morning freshness of an immense sleep. Then it will kill dragons, destroy the crafty dwarf, and awake Brunnhilde—and even Wotan’s spear itself will not be able to block its way!(85) My friends, you who have faith in Dionysian music, you also know what tragedy means to us. In it we have the tragic myth, reborn from music—and in it you can hope for everything and forget what is most distressing! The most painful thing, however, for all of us is this—the long degradation under which the German genius, alienated from house and home, has lived in service to that crafty dwarf. You understand my words—as you will also understand my hopes as I conclude. 25 Music and tragic myth are equally an expression of the Dionysian capacity of a people and are inseparable from each other. Both derive from an artistic realm that lies beyond the Apollonian. Both transfigure a region in whose joyful chords dissonance as well as the terrible image of world fade delightfully away. Both play with the sting of joylessness, trusting in the extreme power of their magical arts. Through this play both justify the existence of even the “worst of worlds.” Here the Dionysian shows itself, measured against the Apollonian, as the eternal and primordial artistic force, which, in general, summons the entire world of appearances into existence. In its midst a new transfiguring illusion becomes necessary in order to keep alive the living world of the individual. Could we imagine dissonance becoming human—and what is a man other than that?—then this dissonance, in order to be able to live on, would need a marvellous illusion, which covered it with a veil of beauty over its essential being. This is the true artistic purpose of Apollo, in whose name we put together all those countless illusions of beautiful appearances which render existence at every moment generally worth living and push us to experience the next moment. But in this process, from that basis for all existence, from the Dionysian bed rock of the world, only as much can come into the consciousness of the human individual as can be overcome once more by that Apollonian power of transfiguration, so that both of these artistic drives are compelled to display their powers in a strictly mutual proportion, in accordance with the law of eternal justice. Wherever Dionysian power rises up too impetuously, as we are experiencing it, there Apollo must already have come down to us, hidden in a cloud. The next generation may well see the richest of his beautiful effects. However, the fact that this effect is necessary each man will experience most surely through his intuition, if he once, even if only in a dream, feels himself set back into the life of the ancient Greeks. As he wanders under high Ionic colonnades, glancing upwards to a horizon marked off with pure and noble lines, with reflections of his transfigured form beside him in shining marble, around him people solemnly striding or moving delicately, with harmoniously resounding sounds and a speech of rhythmic gestures—faced with this constant stream of beauty, would he not

have to extend his hand to Apollo and cry out: “Blessed Hellenic people! How great Dionysus must be among you, if the Delphic god thinks such magic necessary to heal your dithyrambic madness!”—To a person in such a mood as this, however, an old Athenian, looking at him with the noble eye of Aeschylus, might reply: “But, you strange foreigner, say this as well: How much these people must have suffered in order to be able to become so beautiful! But now follow me to the tragedy and sacrifice with me in the temple of both divinities.”

ENDNOTES (1) Note that this first section of the Birth of Tragedy was added to the book many years after it first appeared, as the text makes clear. Nietzsche wrote this “Attempt at Self-Criticism” in 1886. The original text, written in 1870-71, begins with the Preface to Richard Wagner, the second major section in this text. [Back to Text] (2) The Battle of Wörrth occurred in August 1870. The German army defeated the French forces. [Back to Text] (3) Nietzsche contracted a serious and lingering illness while serving as a medical orderly with the Prussian forces in the Franco-Prussian War. The illness forced him eventually to give up his academic position. [Back to Text] (4) In Greek mythology, Dionysus, son of Zeus and the mortal Semele, was the god of wine, associated with ecstatic and intoxicated group rituals. [Back to Text] (5) Socrates: (470-399 BC), Athenian philosopher famous for his devotion to challenging the beliefs of his contemporaries with intense questioning. Also as the main character in Plato’s early dialogues, Socrates becomes the chief spokesman for a more rational understanding of life. [Back to Text] (6) Epicurus: (341-270 BC), Greek philosopher who stressed that the purpose of thinking was the attainment of a tranquil, pain-free existence. [Back to Text] (7) The German word *Wissenschaft*, a very important part of Nietzsche’s argument, has a range of meanings: scholarship, science, scholarly research. In this translation I have normally used science or or scientific knowledge or scholarship. The meaning of the term is by no means confined to what we understand by the term the physical sciences. [Back to Text] (8) Richard Wagner: (1813-1883), German composer and essayist, most famous for his operas. Early in Nietzsche’s career he and Wagner (who met in 1868) were close friends. [Back to Text] (9) . . . maenad-like: a maenad is an ecstatic follower of the god Dionysus. [Back to Text] (10) Pericles: (495-429 BC) political leader of Athens at the height of its power; his Funeral Oration commemorating those Athenians killed in the first year of the Peloponnesian War, as it is described by the great contemporary historian Thucydides (460-395 BC), celebrates the glories of Athens and its citizens. [Back to Text] (11) Schopenhauer: Arthur Schopenhauer (1788-1860), German philosopher whose work had a strong influence on Nietzsche. [Back to Text] (12) Kant: Immanuel Kant (1724-1804), German philosopher, one of the most important figures in the Enlightenment. [Back to Text] (13) A quotation from Goethe’s *Faust II*, 7438-9. The prose quotation before these lines is from Section 18 of *The Birth of*

Tragedy. [Back to Text] (14) Zarathustra: the name Nietzsche uses throughout his works for his reinterpretation of Zoroaster, the ancient Persian prophet, in order to make him a spokesman for his own ideas, notably in *Thus Spake Zarathustra* (1883-1885), from which these concluding paragraphs are quoted. [Back to Text] (15) Apollo: in Greek mythology the son of Zeus and Leto (hence a half-brother of Dionysus), associated with the sun and prophecy. [Back to Text] (16) Lucretius: Titus Lucretius Carus (99 BC to 55 BC), Roman philosopher and poet, author of *De Rerum Natura* (On the Nature of Things). [Back to Text] (17) Hans Sachs: a historical person and a character portrayed in Richard Wagner's opera *Die Meistersinger von Nürnberg*. [Back to Text] (18) . . . the veil of Maja: a phrase used by Schopenhauer to describe a screen which exists between "the world inside my head and the world outside my head." [Back to Text] (19) . . . creator: this quotation comes from Schiller's poem which provides the words for Beethoven's Ode to Joy. Eleusinian mysteries: secret ecstatic religious ceremonies. [Back to Text] (20) . . . head of Medusa: In Greek mythology, Medusa was one of the three monstrous sisters called the Gorgons; her face could turn those who looked at it into stone. [Back to Text] (21) Doric art: An older form of Greek art and architecture which arose in the seventh century BC. [Back to Text] (22) . . . cithara: a traditional stringed instrument. [Back to Text] (23) Prometheus, a Titan, brought fire down from heaven to human beings. Zeus punished him by chaining him to a mountain and sending a vulture to feed on his liver during the day. Oedipus' fatal destiny had him unknowingly kill his father and marry his mother. When he learned the truth, he tore out his own eyes. The House of Atreus suffered from a savage curse which pitted Atreus, father of Agamemnon, against his brother Thyestes. Thyestes' son, Aegisthus, seduced Agamemnon's wife, Clytaemnestra, and together they murdered Agamemnon. Orestes, Agamemnon's only son, avenged his father by killing Aegisthus and his own mother, Clytaemnestra. The Etruscans were the dominant group in central Italy before the rise of the Roman Republic. [Back to Text] (24) The shade of the dead Achilles makes this claim to Odysseus in Book XI of the *Odyssey*. [Back to Text] (25) Schiller: Johann Christoph Friedrich von Schiller (1759-1805), German poet, dramatist, and philosopher. Rousseau: Jean-Jacques Rousseau (1712-1778), European (Swiss/French) philosopher, novelist, and political theorist. His book *Emile*, published in 1762, presents his extremely influential philosophy and program of education. [Back to Text] (26) Raphael: Raphael Sanzio (1483-1520) a major artist of the Renaissance. [Back to Text] (27) Titans: In Greek mythology these were the divine figures before the Olympians. Zeus overthrew and imprisoned them. The barbarian world, for the Greeks, included those people who did not speak Greek, whose language sounded like gibberish to them ("bar . . . bar . . . bar"). [Back to Text] (28) The sphinx was a monster who terrorized the city of Thebes. Oedipus solved the riddle posed by the Sphinx and

was made king of Thebes. The Delphic god is Apollo, who had his major shrine at Delphi. [Back to Text] (29) Dorian art was associated with Sparta, a city state preoccupied with military training, warfare, and an inflexible political system. [Back to Text] (30) Antigone, a daughter of Oedipus, who killed herself rather than obey the state, is the famous tragic heroine of Sophocles' tragedy Antigone. Cassandra, daughter of Priam, king of Troy, was a prophetess. She was given to Agamemnon as a war prize and murdered along with him by Aegisthus and Clytaemnestra when the Greek armies returned home after the Trojan War [Back to Text] (31) Homer: the name given by the Greeks to the author of the Iliad and Odyssey (composed in the eighth century BC); Archilochus: (680 BC to c. 645 BC), Greek poet from the island of Paros. [Back to Text] (32) Terpander: Greek poet in the first half of seventh century BC. The Boy's Magic Horn is a collection of folk songs. [Back to Text] (33) Pindar: (c. 522 BC to 443 BC), Greek lyric poet. [Back to Text] (34) A. W. Schlegel: August Wilhelm von Schlegel: German poet and critic, a major figure in German Romanticism. His *On Dramatic Art and Literature* was published in 1808. [Back to Text] (35) Schiller's preface, *Concerning the Use of the Choir in Tragedy*, was published in 1803. [Back to Text] (36) In the Greek theatre the stage area (sometimes called here the acting area) was an elevated platform stage where the principal actors played their roles. The orchestra, the flat semi-circular area extending in front of the stage area, was the territory of the Chorus. [Back to Text] (37) . . . the Bacchae: the enraptured followers of the god Dionysus. [Back to Text] (38) . . . dithyrambic chorus: The dithyramb was an choral hymn of praise to Dionysus, characterized by a much more ecstatic style than other hymns to the gods, especially to Apollo. [Back to Text] (39) . . . Admetus . . . Alcestis: In Greek mythology, when Admetus, king of Thessaly, was dying from illness, Apollo spared him if he could find someone to die in his place. His wife Alcestis volunteered, and Admetus was spared. Hercules later saved Alcestis from death, and she was reunited with her husband. [Back to Text] (40) The quotation comes from Goethe's *Faust*, Part 1. [Back to Text] (41) Sophocles wrote two surviving plays about the tragedy of Oedipus, king of Thebes: *Oedipus the King* and *Oedipus at Colonus*. The first tells the story of how Oedipus, the wisest man in Thebes, suffers horribly from his own investigations into the murder of his predecessor. The second depicts the reception, years later, of the very old and suffering Oedipus, now near death, by the Athenians. [Back to Text] (42) The quotation comes from Sophocles, *Oedipus the King*, 316. [Back to Text] (43) Memnon's Column: an immense structure in Thebes (in Egypt) beside the temple of Amenhotep III (1400 BC) which gave out sounds when warmed by the sun. [Back to Text] (44) In Goethe's poem, Prometheus addresses these words to Zeus, the chief Olympian god. Prometheus, a Titan, was punished savagely by Zeus for stealing fire from heaven and giving it to human beings. Prometheus

also knew a secret prophecy that the minor goddess Thetis, whom Zeus wanted to have sex with, would have a son more powerful than his father. Aeschylus (525-456 BC), an Athenian tragedian, presents a version of the story in his play *Prometheus Bound*, part of a trilogy in which two plays have not survived.

Goethe: Johann Wolfgang von Goethe (1749-1832), German's greatest writer, author of a poem called *Prometheus*, in which the mythic Prometheus hurls his defiance at Zeus. [Back to Text] (45) Palladium: The Palladium is the divine image or statue which acted as the protector of the state. In a famous incident in the Trojan War, Odysseus and Diomedes stole the Palladium from Troy. [Back to Text] (46) Atlas: in Greek mythology one of the primordial Titans, brother of Prometheus, condemned by Zeus to hold up the sky so that it would remain separated from earth. [Back to Text] (47) A quotation from Goethe's *Faust*. [Back to Text] (48) Euripides: (480-406 BC), a major Athenian tragic dramatist, the last of the celebrated trio of Aeschylus, Sophocles, and Euripides. Dionysus is a principal character in Euripides' last play, the *Bacchae*. [Back to Text] (49) The claim Nietzsche refers to is made by Aristotle in his *Poetics*. [Back to Text] (50) Plato: (428-348 BC), the most important philosopher in classical Greece, distinguished between a real world of ideal forms and the phenomenal world of sense experience, with the latter being an inferior imitation of the former. [Back to Text] (51) According to some Greek myths Zeus and the goddess Demeter were the parents of Zagreus, a child who was torn to pieces by the Titans but who was later born again, either reassembled by Demeter or born to the mortal Semele. Zagreus was identified with the god Dionysus, child of Zeus and Semele. [Back to Text] (52) When Zeus overcame the Titans, who were immortal, he imprisoned them in Tartarus, a region deep within the earth. [Back to Text] (53) Lucians: Lucian of Samosata (125 AD-180 AD), a popular satirist in Roman Syria who wrote in Greek and, among other things, made fun of traditional stories. [Back to Text] (54) Tiberius: Tiberius Caesar August (42 BC to 37 AD), second Roman emperor, after Augustus. Pan: in Greek mythology, a god of the wilderness, hunting, and shepherds. The quotation comes from Plutarch, a Greek historian (46 AD to 120 AD). [Back to Text] (55) Philemon: (c. 362 BC to c. 262 BC), very successful Athenian playwright; Menander: (c. 342 to 291 BC), Greek dramatist, famous for his works of New Comedy. [Back to Text] (56) Graeculus: "little Greek," a pejorative name for a Greek; Aristophanes (456 BC to 386 BC), the greatest dramatist of Old Comedy; his play *Frogs* features a long satiric verbal duel between Euripides and Aeschylus in Hades, an argument about which of them is the better poet and what the features of the best dramatic poetry must be. [Back to Text] (57) Pythagoras: a Greek philosopher in the sixth century BC; Heraclitus: (535 BC to 475 BC), an Ionian philosopher. [Back to Text] (58) Lessing: Gotthold Ephraim Lessing (1729 to 1781), German dramatist, writer, and art critic. [Back to Text] (59) Cadmus and Teiresias:

Cadmus, founder of Thebes, and Teiresias, the blind prophet, are two old men in Euripides' *Bacchae*. They are mocked in the play for their desire to observe the Dionysian rites. At the end of the play, Cadmus is transformed into a dragon. [Back to Text] (60) *Deus ex machina* (lit. "god out of a machine), a term describing the resolution of a complex action by an extremely implausible event (e.g., by having a god come down from on high to sort out all the problems on the spot and to indicate what will happen in future to the main characters). [Back to Text] (61) Anaxagoras: (c. 500 BC to 428 BC), an Ionian materialistic philosopher. [Back to Text] (62) Orpheus: in Greek mythology Orpheus was the pre-eminent poet and musician, who perfected the lyre. He was said to have the power to charm nature with his music. Socrates was charged by the Athenians with impiety, put on trial, and sentenced to death. He died by drinking hemlock, the official method of execution. [Back to Text] (63) Battle of Marathon: (490 BC) one of the highest points of Greek (and especially Athenian) history, when a small force of Greeks, led by the Athenians, defeated the Persian expeditionary force at Marathon, near Athens. According to tradition, Aeschylus fought at Marathon and Sophocles, as a young lad, danced in the victory celebrations. [Back to Text] (64) The Sophists were professional teachers of rhetoric, who had the reputation of using clever arguments to criticize traditional truths and to help their clients and pupils succeed in legal disputes with sophisticated new reasoning, which many people regarded as specious. Aristophanes portrays Socrates as the leader of a school of sophistic reasoning in his play *Clouds*. Alcibiades: (450 BC to 404 BC) was an erratic and charismatic Athenian politician and military officer, who repeatedly changed his allegiance during the Peloponnesian War). [Back to Text] (65) The quotation comes from Goethe's *Faust*. [Back to Text] (66) Cyclops: In Greek mythology a cyclops was a huge, one-eyed monster living in the wilderness. [Back to Text] (67) Gellert: Christian Fürchtegott Gellert (1715-1769), German poet and professor of philosophy, famous for his moralistic fables. Aesop: a sixth century BC Greek writer, by tradition a slave, who is known only for the moralistic tales that bear his name. [Back to Text] (68) In Plato's theory of knowledge, reality is ideal and can be apprehended only through the intellect, not through the senses. The sensible world around us contains imitations of that ideal reality (empirical objects copy or participate in the Idea of the object). [Back to Text] (69) The Cynic writers: The Cynics, an important school of philosophy in the fifth century BC, encouraged a moral life free of material wealth. [Back to Text] (70) Mephistopheles . . . Lamia: In Goethe's *Faust*, Mephistopheles is a representation of the Devil. Lamia is an alternative name for Lilith, Adam's first wife. In *Faust* she is portrayed as a beautiful seductive woman. [Back to Text] (71) Palestrina: Giovanni Pierluigi da Palestrina (1525 to 1594), Italian musician, famous for his polyphonic vocal harmonies. [Back to Text] (72) In Greek mythology Orpheus

and Amphion were extraordinarily gifted musicians. [Back to Text] (73) In the first part of Dante's *Divine Comedy*, the Roman poet Virgil is the narrator's guide through the circles of Hell but has to leave him as the narrator moves up into Purgatory and Paradise. [Back to Text] (74) Hercules . . . Omphale: In Greek mythology, the great hero Hercules had to serve for three years as a slave to Omphale, queen of Lydia, in retribution for murder. [Back to Text] (75) Otto Jahn: (1813 to 1869), German scholar of archaeology and philology and writer on music. [Back to Text] (76) Heraclitus: (c. 535 to 475 BC), pre-Socratic Greek philosopher from Asia Minor. [Back to Text] (77) Winckelmann: Johann Joachim Winckelmann (1717-1768), German art historian and archaeologist, an important figure in the study of the classical Greeks. [Back to Text] (78) Dürer: Albrecht Dürer (1471 to 1528), German painter, particularly famous for his prints. [Back to Text] (79) Persian Wars: Persian forces invaded Greece twice, in 490 and in 480 BC. The first expedition ended with the Battle of Marathon and the second with the naval battle of Salamis and the land battle of Plataea. These victories were high points of classical Hellenic experience, particularly for the spirit of courage and cooperation they displayed in the face of what looked like insuperable odds. [Back to Text] (80) Gervinus: Georg Gottfried Gervinus (1805 to 1871), German literary and political historian. [Back to Text] (81) *Tristan and Isolde*: an opera by Richard Wagner, first performed in 1865. [Back to Text] (82) These lines come from Wagner's opera *Tristan and Isolde*, Act III. [Back to Text] (83) Schopenhauer's famous parable of the porcupines illustrates the dilemma people face in their relationships with others: if, in the attempt to stay warm, they get too close they will be hurt (i.e., by the quills on other porcupines), but if they remain too far apart they will suffer from loneliness and cold. Hence, they need to find the appropriate distance where they can obtain sufficient warmth and yet avoid being hurt. [Back to Text] (84) *Lohengrin*: an opera by Richard Wagner, first produced in 1848. [Back to Text] (85) Wotan and his daughter, Brunnhilde are characters in Richard Wagner's opera cycle *The Ring of the Nibelungen*. The crafty dwarf, also a character in the work, is Alberich who guards the Rhinegold treasure. [Back to Text]

Part II

Untimely Meditations

1873–1876 — *Translated by R.J. Hollingdale*

David Strauss, the Confessor and the Writer Public opinion in Germany seems almost to forbid discussion of the evil and perilous consequences of a war, and especially of one that has ended victoriously: there is thus all the more ready an ear for those writers who know no weightier authority than this public opinion and who therefore vie with one another in lauding a war and in seeking out the mighty influence it has exerted on morality, culture and art. This notwithstanding, it has to be said that a great victory is a great danger. Human nature finds it harder to endure a victory than a defeat; indeed, it seems to be easier to achieve a victory than to endure it in such a way that it does not in fact turn into a defeat. Of all the evil consequences, however, which have followed the recent war with France* perhaps the worst is a widespread, indeed universal, error: the error, committed by public opinion and by all who express their opinions publicly, that German culture too was victorious in that struggle and must therefore now be loaded with garlands appropriate to such an extraordinary achievement. This delusion is in the highest degree destructive: not because it is a delusion - for there exist very salutary and productive errors but because it is capable of turning our victory into a defeat: into the defeat, if not the extirpation, of the German spirit for the benefit of the (German Reich'. Even supposing that a war of this kind were in fact a war between two cultures, the value of the victor would still be a very relative one and could certainly not justify choruses of victory or acts of self glorification. For one would have to know what the defeated culture had been worth: perhaps it was worth very little: in which case the victory of the victorious culture, even if attended by the most magnificent success in arms, would constitute no invitation to ecstatic triumphs. On the other hand, in the present case there can be no question of a victory of German culture, for the simple reason that French culture continues to exist as heretofore, and we are dependent upon it as heretofore. Our culture played no part even in our success in arms. Stern discipline, natural bravery and endurance, superior generalship, unity and obedience in the ranks, in *The 'recent war with France' is [the Franco-Prussian War of 1870-1871]. (This and all subsequent notes are by the translator.) :11 short, elements that have nothing to do with culture, procured for us the victory over opponents in whom the most important of these elements were lacking: the wonder is that that which at present calls itself 'culture' in

Germany proved so small an obstacle to the military demands which had to be met for the achievement of a great success - perhaps it was only because that which calls itself culture foresaw a greater advantage in subordinating itself this time. But if it is now allowed to grow and luxuriate, if it is pampered with the flattering delusion that the victory belonged to it, then it will, as I have said, have the power to extirpate the German spirit - and who knows whether the German body remaining will be of any use whatever! If it were possible to take that calm and tenacious bravery which the German demonstrated against the emotional and shordived impetuosity of the French and turn it against the enemy within, against that highly ambiguous and in any case alien 'cultivatedness' which is nowadays dangerously misunderstood to constitute cul ture, then all hope for the creation of a genuine German culture, the antithesis of this cultivatedness, would nCjt be lost: for the Germans have never lacked clear-sighted and courageous leaders and generals - though these have frequently lacked Germans. But whether it is in fact possible to redirect German bravery in this way seems to me more and more doubtful and, after the late war, daily more improbable; for I see how everyone is convinced that struggle and bravery are no longer required, but that, on the contrary, most things are regulated in the finest possible way and that in any case everything that needed doing has long since been done - in short, . that the finest seeds of culture have everywhere been sown and are in places bursting into leaf and even into luxuriant blossom. In this realm it is not mere complacency, but joy and jubilation which reign. I sense this joy and jubilation in the incomparable self assurance of our German journalists and manufacturers of novels, tragedies, songs and histories: for these types patently belong together in a single guild which seems to have entered into a con spiracy to take charge of the leisure and ruminative hours of modern man - that is to say, his 'cultural moments' - and in these to stun him with printed paper. Since the war, all is happiness, dignity and self awareness in this guild: after such 'successes of German culture' it feels itself not merely confirmed and sanctioned, but almost sac rosanct; and it therefore speaks more solemnly, takes pleasure in addressing itself to the German people, publishes collected editions in the manner of the classics, and goes so far as to employ those David Strauss, the confessor and the writer international journals which stand at its service to proclaim certain individuals from its midst as the new German classics and model writers. One might perhaps have expected that the more thoughtful and learned among cultivated Germans would have recognized the dangers inherent in such a misuse of success, or at least have felt this spectacle as painful: for what could be more painful than the sight of a deformed man pluming himself before the mirror like a cockerel and exchanging admiring glances with his reflection? But the learned classes are happy to let happen what is happening, and have in any case quite enough to do in maintaining themselves without the additional burden of looking after the

welfare of the German spirit. Its members are, moreover, supremely convinced that their own culture is the ripest and fairest fruit of the age, indeed of all the ages, and cannot comprehend why anyone should need to look after the welfare of German culture in general, since they themselves and countless numbers like them have already gone far, far beyond all such considerations. The more cautious observer, however, especially if he is a foreigner, cannot help noticing that what the German scholar now calls his culture and that jubilant culture of the new German classics differ from one another only in the extent of their knowledge: wherever the question is one not of knowledge and information, but of art and ability - wherever, that is to say, life bears witness to the culture - there is now only one German culture: and is it this that is supposed to have triumphed over France? Such an assertion seems completely incomprehensible: all impartial judges, and finally the French themselves, have seen Germany's decisive advantage to have lain in the more extensive knowledge possessed by its officers, in the superior training of its troops, and in the greater science of its conduct of the war. In what sense, then, can German culture be said to have triumphed, if one thinks to deduct from it German erudition? In no sense: for the moral qualities of stricter discipline and readier obedience have nothing to do with culture - though they distinguished the Macedonian soldiery from the Greek, for example, the latter were incomparably more cultured. It can only be the result of confusion if one speaks of the victory of German culture, a confusion originating in the fact that in Germany there no longer exists any clear conception of what culture is. Culture is, above all, unity of artistic style in all the expressions of the life of a people. Much knowledge and learning is neither an essential means to culture nor a sign of it, and if needs be can get along very well with the opposite of culture, barbarism, which is lack of style or a chaotic jumble of all styles. It is in such a chaotic jumble of styles that the German of our day dwells: and one seriously wonders how, with all his erudition, he can possibly fail to notice it, but, on the contrary, rejoices from the very heart at the 'culture' he at present possesses. For everything ought to instruct him: every glance he casts at his clothes, his room, his home, every walk he takes through the streets of his town, every visit he pays to a fashionable shop; in his social life he ought to be aware of the origin of his manners and deportment, in the world of our artistic institutions, of our concerts, theatres and museums, he ought to notice the grotesque juxtaposition and confusion of different styles. The German amasses around him the forms and colours, productions and curiosities of every age and every clime, and produces that modern fairground motley which his learned colleagues are then obliged to observe and classify as the 'modern as such', while he himself remains seated calmly in the midst of the tumult. But with this kind of 'culture', which is in fact only a phlegmatic lack of all feeling for culture, one cannot overcome enemies, least of all those who, like the French, actually

possess a real and productive culture, regardless of what its value may be, and from whom we have hitherto copied everything, though usually with little skill. If we had in fact ceased to copy it we would not thereby have triumphed over it, but only have liberated ourselves from it: only if we had imposed upon the French an original German culture could there be any question of a victory of German culture. In the mean time, we should not forget that we are still dependent on Paris in all matters of form, just as before and that we have to go on being dependent, for up to now there has been no original German culture. We all ought to have been aware of this from our own knowledge: in addition to which, one of the few who had a right to speak to the Germans of it in a tone of reproach has publicly revealed it. 'We Germans are of yesterday', Goethe once said to Eckermann; 'it is true that we have been soundly cultivating ourselves for a century, but another couple of centuries may have to pass before sufficient spirit and higher culture has penetrated our countrymen and become general for it to be possible to say of them: it is a long time since they were barbarians.' *

*Goethe to Eckermann, on 3 May 1827. David Strauss) the confessor and the writer If, however, our public and private life so manifestly does not bear the stamp of a productive and stylistically secure culture, if our great artists, moreover, have admitted and continue to admit this dreadful and, for a gifted people, profoundly humiliating fact, how is it possible that the greatest self-satisfaction nonetheless continues to reign among educated Germans: a self-satisfaction which since the recent war has shown itself ready to burst out in cries of jubilation and triumph? In any event, there exists a steadfast belief that we are in possession of a genuine culture: the enormous incongruity between this complacent, indeed exultant belief and an in fact notorious cultural deficiency seems to be apparent only to the select few. For all those whose views coincide with public opinion have covered their eyes and stopped their ears the incongruity must not be admitted to exist. How is this possible? What force is so powerful as to dictate such a 'must not'? What species of man must have come to dominate in Germany that such strong and simple feelings can be prohibited and expression of them obstructed? I shall call this power, this species of man, by its name - it is the cultural philistine. The word 'philistine', as is well known, belongs to the student vocabulary, and signifies, in its wider, popular sense, the antithesis of a son of the muses, of the artist, of the man of genuine culture. The cultural philistine, however - the study of whom, and the hearing of whose confessions when he makes them, has now become a disagreeable duty distinguishes himself from the general idea of the species 'philistine' through a superstition: he fancies that he is himself a son of the muses and man of culture; an incomprehensible delusion which reveals that he does not even know what a philistine, and the antithesis of a philistine, is: so we shall not be surprised to find that usually he solemnly denies he is a philistine. With this lack of all self-

knowledge, he feels firmly convinced that his 'culture' is the complete expression of true German culture: , and since he everywhere discovers cultivated people of his own kind, and finds all public institutions, schools and cultural and artistic bodies organized in accordance with his kind of cultivation and in the service of his requirements, he also bears with him everywhere the triumphant feeling of being the worthy representative of contemporary German culture and frames his demands and pretensions accordingly. If, however, true culture must in any event presuppose unity of style, and even an inferior and degenerate culture cannot be thought of as failing to exhibit a stylistic unity within which the manifold phenomena which characterize it are harmonized, this confusion reigning in the deluded mind of the cultural philistine may well originate in the fact that, discovering everywhere identical reproductions of himself, he infers from this identity of all 'cultivated' people the existence of a unity of style and thus the existence of a German culture. He perceives around him nothing but needs identical with and views similar to his own; wherever he goes he is at once embraced by a bond of tacit conventions in regard to many things, especially in the realms of religion and art: this impressive homogeneity, this *tutti unisono** which no one commands but which is always ready to break forth, seduces him to the belief that a culture here holds sway. But systematic and oppressive philistinism does not constitute a culture, even an inferior culture, merely because it possesses system: it must always be the antithesis of a culture, namely a permanently established barbarity. For that uniformity which is so striking in the cultivated people of Germany today is a unity only through the conscious or unconscious exclusion and negation of every artistically productive form and the demand of a true style. An unhappy contortion must have taken place in the brain of the cultural philistine: he regards as culture precisely that which negates culture, and since he is accustomed to proceed with consistency he finally acquires a coherent collection of such negations, a system of un-culture, to which one might even concede a certain 'unity of style' if it made any sense to speak of a barbarism with style. If he is allowed to choose between a stylistically agreeable action and one of the opposite kind, he invariably elects the latter, and because he always does so all his actions bear the same negative stamp. It is precisely this negative stamp which enables him to recognize the nature of the 'German culture' he has patented: whatever does not correspond to it he adjudges hostile and inimical to him. In this case the cultural philistine does no more than defend himself: he denies, secretes, stops his ears, averts his eyes, he is a negative being even in his hatred and hostility. The person he hates most of all, however, is him who treats him as a philistine and tells him what he is: a hindrance to the strong and creative, a labyrinth for all who doubt and go astray, a swamp to the feet of the weary, a fetter to all who would pursue lofty goals, a poisonous mist to new buds, a parching desert "tutti unisono: everybody, together David Strauss, the

confessor and the writer to the German spirit seeking and thirsting for new life. For it seeks, this German spirit! and you hate it because it seeks and refuses to believe you when you say you have already found what it is seeking. How is it possible that a type such as the cultural philistine could have come into existence and, once extant, could acquire the authority of supreme arbiter over all the problems of German culture; how is this possible, after there has filed past us a whole line of great heroic figures whose every movement, every feature, whose questioning voice, whose burning eye, betrayed but one thing: that they were seekers, and that what they were seeking with such perseverance was precisely that which the cultural philistine fancied he already possessed: a genuine, original German culture. Is there a ground, they seemed to ask, so pure, so untouched, of such virginal holiness, that the German spirit may raise its house upon this ground and upon no other? Questioning thus, they made their way through the wilderness and thorns of wretched and meagre ages, and as seekers they passed from our sight: so that one of them, speaking for all, could say in his old age; 'I have toiled for half a century and allowed myself no rest, but have continually striven and sought and worked as well and as hard as I could.'* But what view does our philistine culture take of these seekers? It assumes them to be finders, not seekers, and seems to forget that it was as seekers that they regarded themselves. 'We have our culture, do we not?' they say, 'for we have our classics, do we not? Not only have the foundations been laid, but the building itself stands already upon them - we ourselves are this building.' And the philistine raises his hand to his own brow. Thus to misjudge our classics, however, and in thinking to honour them thus to damn them, it is necessary not to know them: and this is indeed the universal fact. For otherwise it would be known that there is only one way of honouring them, and that is to go on seeking in their spirit and with their courage, and not to grow weary of doing so. On the other hand, to affix to them the suspect word 'classic' and from time to time to 'edify' oneself with their works is to resign one self to those feeble and egoistic sensations promised by our concert halls and theatres to anyone who can pay for them; the same applies to the erection of statues of them and the naming of festivals and societies after them - all these things are merely cash payments by means of which the cultural philistine settles accounts with them so "Goethe to Eckermann, 14 March 1830. as not to have to follow after them and to go on seeking. For 'All seeking is at an end' is the motto of the philistines. There was a time when this motto was to some extent sensible: the time when, during the first decade of the present century, so much confused seeking, experimenting, wrecking, promising, surmising, hoping was going on in Germany that the spiritual middle class was right to fear for its own safety. At that time it was right to reject with a shrug of the shoulders the brew of fantastic and language-twisting philosophies and tendentious historiographies, a carnival of all the gods and

myths, which the Romantics had mixed together, and to reject too the current poetic fashions and follies dreamed up in a state of intoxication - right, that is, because the philistine does not have the right even to a debauch. With the craftiness pertaining to baser natures, however, he took the opportunity thus afforded to cast suspicion on seeking as such and to promote a comfortable consciousness of having already found. His eyes were opened to the joys of philistinism: he saved himself from all the wild experimentation going on by a flight into the idyllic, and to the resolutely creative drive of the artist he opposed a certain easy complacency, a self contentment in one's own limitations, one's own placidity, even in one's own narrow-mindedness. His attenuated finger pointed, without any false modesty, to the hidden and secret corners of his life, to the many moving and naive pleasures which sprang up like blushing flowers in the most wretched depths of the uncultivated existence and as it were mire of the philistine world. There were a number of representational talents who, with a gentle brush, depicted the happiness, the cosiness, the prosaicness, the bucolic health, the ease and contentment to be found in the nursery, the scholar's study and the farmhouse. With such picture books of reality in their hands, these self-satisfied people then sought to come to terms once and for all with the classics they found so unsettling and with the demand for further seeking which proceeded from them; they devised the concept of the epigone-age with the object of obtaining peace and quiet and so as to meet every uncomfortable innovation with the condemnatory verdict 'epigone work'. It was these same self-contented people who, with the same end in view of guaranteeing their own peace, took charge of history and sought to transform every science which might be expected to disturb their complacency into an historical discipline, especially so in the case of philosophy and classical philology. Through historical awareness they saved themselves from enthusiasm for history was 10 David Strauss, the confessor and the writer no longer supposed to engender enthusiasm, even though Goethe might think it did: stupefaction is now the goal of these unphilosophical admirers of *nil admirari** when they seek to understand everything historically. While professing to hate fanaticism and intolerance in any form, what they really hated was the dominating genius and the tyranny of the real demands of culture; and that is why they employed all their powers in paralyzing, stupefying or disrupting all those quarters where fresh and powerful movements might be expected to appear. A philosophy which chastely concealed behind arabesque flourishes the philistine confession of its author invented in addition a formula for the apotheosis of the commonplace: it spoke of the rationality of the real, and thus ingratiated itself with the cultural philistine, who also loves arabesque flourishes but above all conceives himself alone to be real and treats his reality as the standard of reason in the world. He now permitted everyone, himself included, to reflect, to research, to aestheticize, above all to compose poetry and

music, to paint pictures, even to create entire philosophies: the sole proviso was that everything must remain as it was before, that nothing should at any price undermine the 'rational' and the 'rôal', that is to say, the philistine. The latter, to be sure, is very partial to abandoning himself from time to time to the pleasant and daring extravagances of art and sceptical his toriography and knows how to appreciate the charm of such forms of entertainment and distraction; but he sternly segregates the 'serious things of life' - that is to say profession, business, wife and child - from its pleasures: and to the latter belongs more or less everything that has anything to do with culture. Therefore woe to an art that starts to take itself seriously and makes demands that touch upon his livelihood, his business and his habits, in short, his philis tine 'serious things of life' he averts his eyes from such an art as though from something indecent, and with the air of a duenna he warns every defenceless virtue not to look. Being so fond of dissuading, he is grateful to the artist who pays heed to him and lets himself be dissuaded; he gives him to under stand that henceforth no sublime masterpieces are to be demanded of him, but only two much easier things: either imitation of actuality to the point of mimicry in idylls or gently humorous satires, or free copies of the most familiar and famous of the classics, though incor porating timid concessions to the taste of the time. For when he ""nil admirari: to wonder at nothing 1 1 values only the imitations of an epigone or the icon-like portraiture of the present, he knows that the latter will glorify him and augment general contentment with 'actuality', while the former, as well as being quite harmless, will even enhance his reputation as a judge of classical taste - for he has, as aforesaid, come to terms once and for all with the classics themselves. Finally, he invents for his habits, modes of thinking, likes and dislikes, the general formula 'healthi ness', and dismisses every uncomfortable disturber of the peace as being sick and neurotic. Thus David Strauss, a true satisfait with the state of our culture and a typical philistine, once spoke character istically of 'Arthur Schopenhauer's ingenious but in many ways unhealthy and unprofitable philosophizing'. For it is a cruel fact that 'the spirit' is accustomed most often to descend upon the 'unhealthy and unprofitable', and on those occasions when he is honest with himself even the philistine is aware that the philosophies his kind produce and bring to market are in many ways spiritless, though they are of course extremely healthy and profitable. For now and then the philistines, whel) they are alone by them selves, take wine together and recall, in honest, naive and loquacious fashion, the great deeds of the war; on these occasions many things come to light that are otherwise anxiously concealed, and some times one of them even lets out the fundamental secrets of the entire brotherhood. Such a thing occurred very recently in the case of a celebrated aesthete of the Hegelian school of reasoning. The provocation was, to be sure, sufficiently unusual: a circle of philis tines was celebrating the memory of a true and genuine non philistine, and one

moreover who in the strictest sense of the word perished by the philistines: the memory of the glorious Hölderlin; and the well-known aesthetician thus had a right on this occasion to speak of tragic souls which perish through contact with 'reality' - the word reality here understood in the sense, already alluded to, of philistine rationality. But 'reality' is now something different from what it was in Hölderlin's day, and it may well be asked whether he would have been able to find his way in the present great age. 'I do not know', said Friedrich Vischer, 'whether his gentle soul could have endured all the harshness involved in any war or all the rottenness we have seen advancing since the war in every sphere of life. Perhaps he would again have sunk back into despair. He was one of the unarmed souls, he was the Werther of Greece, a lover without hope; his was a life full of gentleness and desire, but there was also strength and substance in his will, and greatness, richness and life in it.' David Strauss, the confessor and the writer of his style, which now and then reminds us of Aeschylus. Only his spirit had too little of hardness in it; he lacked the weapon of humour; he could not admit that one can be a philistine without being a barbarian.' It is this last confession, and not the sugary condolences of the after-dinner speaker, that concerns us. Yes, one admits to being a philistine - but a barbarian! Not at any price. Poor Hölderlin was, alas, incapable of drawing such fine distinctions. If, to be sure, one understands by the word barbarian the opposite of civilization, or even equates it with such things as piracy and cannibalism, then the distinction is justified; but what the aesthetician is plainly trying to say is that one can be a philistine and at the same time a man of culture - this is the joke that poor Hölderlin had not the humour to see and the lack of which destroyed him. On this occasion a second admission escaped the speaker: 'It is not always strength of will, but weakness, which enables us to transcend that longing for the beautiful experienced so profoundly by tragic souls' - that, or something like it, was the confession, deposed in the name of the assembled 'we', that is to say the 'transcenders', the 'transcenders through weakness'! Let us be content with these admissions! For we now know two things, and from the mouth of an initiate: first, that this 'we' has really got free of the desire for beauty, has indeed actually transcended it; and, secondly, that this was accomplished through weakness! In less indiscrete moments this weakness had been called by a fairer name: it was the celebrated 'healthiness' of the cultural philistines. After this latest information, however, it might be advisable henceforth to refer to them, not as the 'healthy', but as the weaklings or, more strongly, as the weak. If only these weak were not in possession of the power! What can it matter to them what they are called! For they are the masters, and he is no genuine master who cannot endure a mocking nickname. Indeed, provided one possesses the power, one is even free to mock at one self. It does not really matter then whether one exposes oneself to attack: for what does the purple, the mantle of triumph, not protect! The strength of the

cultural philistine comes to light when he admits his weakness: and the more often and more cynically he admits it, the more clearly he betrays his feelings of self-importance and superiority. This is the age of cynical philistine confessions. As Friedrich Vischer made aural confession, so David Strauss has confessed with a book: that aural confession was cynical, and so is this book of confessions. 1 3 David Strauss makes a twofold confession regarding philistine culture: confession by word and confession by deed - the word of the confessor and the deed of the writer. His book entitled *The Old Faith and the New* is, with regard to its content and with regard to its quality as a book and the production of a writer, an uninterrupted confession; and that he should permit himself to make public confession as to his beliefs at all already constitutes a confession. * - It may be that everyone over forty has the right to compile an autobiography, for even the humblest of us may have experienced and seen from closer quarters things which the thinker may find worth noticing. But to depose a confession of one's beliefs must be considered incomparably more presumptuous, since it presupposes that the writer accords value, not merely to what he has experienced or discovered or seen during his life, but even to what he has believed. Now, the last thing the real thinker will wish to know is what kind of beliefs are agreeable to such natures as Strauss or; what it is they 'have half dreamily cobbled together' (p. 1 0) in regard to things of which only he who knows them at first hand has a right to speak. Who could need the confessions of belief of a Ranke or a Mommsen, even though they are scholars and historians of an order quite different from David Strauss? As soon as they sought to interest us in their beliefs rather than in their knowledge they would be overstepping their bounds in a very annoying fashion. But this is what Strauss does when he tells us of his beliefs. No one wishes to know anything about them, except perhaps certain narrow-minded opponents of the Straussian dogmas who feel that there must lie behind them a system of truly diabolical principles and would no doubt want Strauss to compromise his learned utterances by betraying this diabolical background. Perhaps these uncouth fellows have even benefited from Strauss's latest book; the rest of us, however, who have had no reason to suspect the existence of such a diabolical background, have done no such thing - we would, indeed, have been grateful if we had found a little diabolism in these pages. For the voice of Strauss speaking of his new faith is certainly not the voice of an evil spirit: it is not the voice of a spirit at all, let alone that of an actual genius. It is the voice of those people whom Strauss introduces to us as his 'we' - they are, he says, 'scholars and artists, * Strauss's *Der alte und neue Glaube* was published in 1872. Nietzsche's page references are to the original edition. An English translation by Mathilde Blind appeared in 1873. 1 4 David Strauss, the confessor and the writer office workers and soldiers, tradesman and landed proprietors, in their thousands and by no means the worst in the land' - and who, when they tell us of their beliefs, bore us even more than

when they tell us of their dreams. When they choose to break their silence and noise their confessions, the volume of their unisono must not be allowed to deceive us as to the poverty and vulgarity of the tune they sing. How can the knowledge that a belief is shared by many make us more favourably disposed towards it when we also know that if any one of the many ventured to tell us of it we should not let him finish but interrupt him with a yawn? If you have such a belief, we should have to tell him, for God's sake keep quiet about it. It may be that in earlier years a few simple people sought a thinker in David Strauss: now they have discovered him to be a believer and are disappointed. If he had stayed silent* he would have remained a philosopher, at least so far as these people are concerned: now he is a philosopher to no one. But he no longer desires the honour of being a thinker; he wants only to be a new believer, and is proud of his 'new faith'. Confessing it in writing, he thinks he is inscribing the catechism 'of modern ideas' and constructing the broad 'universal highway of the future'. In fact, our philistine no longer hesitates to say anything, but has grown self-assured to the point of cynicism. There was a time- a very distant time, to be sure - when the philistine was tolerated as something that said nothing and of which nothing was said: there was another time when one flattered his oddities, found him amusing and talked about him. This attention gradually turned him into a coxcomb and he began to take an inordinate pride in his oddities and ingenuous queer-headedness: now he himself talks, often in the manner of Riehl's music for the home. 'But what is this I see! Is it phantom or reality? How long and broad my poodle grows!' For now he is already trundling like a hippopotamus along the 'universal highway of the future' and his growling and barking has changed into the proud accents of the founder of a religion. Are you perhaps thinking, Master, of founding the religion of the future? 'It seems to me that the time has not yet come. It does not even occur to me to want to destroy any existing church' (p. 8). - But why not, Master? All that matters is that one is able to. Besides, to speak frankly, you yourself believe you are able to: you have only to look at the last page of your book. There you say that your new highway 'is the sole uni- "if he had stayed silent": Nietzsche's German version of the Latin 'si tacuisses, philosophus mansisses' tFrom Goethe's Faust, Part I Scene 3. 1 5 versal highway of the future, which needs only to be gradually completed and above all more travelled along for it to become pleasant and comfortable'. Therefore deny it no longer: the founder of a religion has been unmasked, the new, pleasant and comfortable road to the Straussian paradise has been constructed. All you are not yet content with, you modest man, is the carriage in which you wish to drive us; you tell us in your closing words: 'that the carriage to which my valued readers have had to entrust themselves with me meets every requirement I would not venture to assert' (p. 367): 'we have been much buffeted about'. Ah hal you are fishing for compliments, you coquettish religion-founder! We, however, would

prefer to tell you the truth. If your reader prescribes himself the 368 pages of your religious catechism at the rate of one page every day of the year if, that is to say, he takes it in the smallest possible doses - we believe that at the end of it he will feel unwell: out of vexation that it has failed to produce any effect. Gulp down in mouthfuls, however, as much as possible at once according to the prescription for all timely books, the draught can do it no harm: far from feeling vexed and unwell, the drinker will be in a merry and happy mood, just as though nothing has happened, no religion had been destroyed, no universal highway constructed, no confession made - and that is what I call an effect! Physician and medicaments and sickness all forgotten! And the joyful laughter! The continual incitement to laughter! You are to be envied, dear sir, for you have founded the most agreeable religion in the world: a religion whose founder is continually honoured by being laughed at. The philistine as the founder of the religion of the future - that is the new faith in its most impressive shape; the philistine become a visionary - that is the unheard-of phenomenon that distinguishes Germany today. Let us, however, preserve for the moment a degree of caution in regard to this visionary enthusiasm: has David Strauss himself not urged such caution upon us, in the following passage (p. 80), in which, to be sure, we are supposed to recognize in the first instance not Strauss but the founder of Christianity: 'We know there have been noble, gifted visionaries, a visionary can arouse and exalt us, and can produce a very lasting effect historically; but let us not choose him as our life-guide. He will lead us astray if we do not subject his influence to the control of reason.' We know even more, 16 David Strauss, the confessor and the writer indeed: there have also been ungifted visionaries, visionaries who do not arouse and fire us and yet intend to produce a very lasting effect historically as life-guides and to dominate the future: how much more is it incumbent upon us to subject their visionary enthusiasm to the control of reason. Lichtenberg even says: 'There are enthusiastic visionaries devoid of ability, and these are truly dangerous people.' For the present, and in aid of this control by reason, we would like an honest answer to three questions. First: how does the new believer imagine his Heaven? Secondly: how far does the courage bestowed on him by the new faith extend? And thirdly: how does he write his books? Strauss the confessor shall answer the first and second questions for us, Strauss the writer the third. The Heaven of the new believer will naturally have to be a Heaven on earth: for the Christian 'prospect of an immortal Heavenly life' has, together with the other consolations of Christianity, 'irrevocably fallen away' for him who has 'even one foot' in the Straussian camp (p. 364). There is some significance in how a religion elects to depict its Heaven: and if it be true that Christianity knows no other Heavenly occupation than music-making and singing, then the Strauss-ian philistine cannot very well be expected to look forward to it. The confessional book does, however, contain one paradisaical page, page 294: unroll

this parchment first of all, most fortunate philistine! All Heaven will there climb down to you. 'We shall give only an indication', Strauss says, 'of what we do, of what we have done these many years. Besides our profession - for we belong to the most varied professions, we are by no means only scholars or artists but also office workers and soldiers, tradesmen and landed proprietors, and, to say it again, there are not a few of us but many thousands and not the worst in any country besides our profession, I say, we try to keep our minds as open as possible to all the higher interests of mankind: during recent years we have participated in the liveliest way in the great national war and the construction of the German state, and we feel ourselves profoundly uplifted by this turn, as glorious as it was unexpected, in the history of our much tried nation. We assist our understanding of these things through historical studies, which have now been made easy even for the unlearned by a series of attractive and popularly written historical works; at the same time, we seek to broaden our knowledge of nature, for which there is likewise no lack of aids accessible to the common understanding; and lastly, we find in the writings of our great poets, in performances of the works of our great composers, a stimulus for the spirit and the heart, for the imagination and the sense of humour, that leaves nothing to be desired. Thus we live and go our way rejoicing.' This is our man, cries the philistine who reads this: for that is how we live, how we live every day! * And what a nice turn of phrase he has to describe things! When, for example, he refers to historical studies by means of which we assist our understanding of the political situation, what can he be referring to but newspaper-reading, and when he speaks of our lively participation in the construction of the German state, what can he mean but our daily visits to the public house? and is a stroll through the zoo not what is meant by 'aids accessible to the common understanding' through which we broaden our knowledge of nature? And finally the theatres and concerts from which we take home 'stimuli for the imagination and sense of humour' which 'leave nothing to be desired' - how wittily he dignifies these dubious activities! This is our man: for his Heaven is our Heaven! Thus the philistine cries and rejoices: and if we are not as contented as he is, the reason is that we wanted to know more. Scaliger asked: 'What is it to us whether Montaigne drank red wine or white!' But in this more important case how much we should treasure such detailed information! If only we could know how many pipes the philistine must smoke each day according to the dictates of the new faith, and whether he prefers the Spener or the National-Zeitung when he is drinking his coffee. Our thirst for knowledge is not satisfied! On only one point do we receive something of what we desire, but this, happily, concerns the philistine's Heaven of Heavens: the private little aesthetic closets consecrated to the great poets and composers in which the philistine not merely 'edifies' himself but in which, according to his confession, 'all his blemishes are effaced and

washed away' (p. 363); so that we appear to have to envisage these closets as kinds of little bathrooms. 'But that is only for fleeting moments, it happens only in the realm of the imagination and is valid only therein; as soon as we return to rude reality and the daily round, the old cares descend upon us again from all sides' - thus sighs our teacher, Strauss. Yet if we employ the fleeting moments for which we are allowed to linger in those little closets, there will be just enough time to view from all sides a picture of the ideal philistine, that is to say the philistine from whom all blemishes have been washed away and who is now the philistine type in all its purity. What here pre- *This phrase is from a German students' song. 18 David Strauss, the confessor and the writer sends itself is, in all seriousness, instructive: let no one who has fallen victim to the confessional book let it go without having read the excursus 'on our great poets' or that 'on our great composers'. Here there extends the rainbow of the new guild, and he who cannot take joy in it 'is beyond all help', is, as Strauss says on another occasion but could also say here, 'not yet ripe for our viewpoint'. For we are, remember, in the Heaven of Heavens. The enthusiastic peripatetic sets about leading us around, and apologizes if, carried away by the pleasure he takes in all these wonderful things, he talks a little too much. 'If I perchance grow more loquacious than is thought appropriate to the occasion', he tells us, 'I ask the reader's indulgence: out of the fullness of the heart the mouth speaketh. Let him be assured, however, that what he is now going to read is not drawn from earlier writings and inserted here, but written for the present purpose and the present place' (p. 296). This confession momentarily staggers us. of what interest can it be to us whether or not these charming little chapters are newly written! If only it were a matter of writing! Between ourselves, I wish they had been written 25 years ago: for then I would know why the ideas in them seem to me so pallid and why the odour of mouldering antiques adheres to them. But that something written in 1872 should smell mouldy in 1872 arouses my suspicions. Suppose someone fell asleep while reading these chapters and imbibing their odour- what would he be likely to dream about? A friend of mine gave me the answer, for it happened to him. He dreamed of a waxworks show: the classic authors stood there, delicately imitated in wax and gems. They moved their arms and eyes and a screw inside them squeaked as they did so. He then saw something uncanny, a formless figure draped in ribbons and gilt paper with a label hanging from its mouth and 'Lessing' written on it; my friend said he stepped closer and learned the worst: it was the Homeric chimera, Strauss in front, Gervinus behind, in the middle chimera - in summa, Lessing. This discovery wrung from him a scream of fear, he awoke and read no further. Why, Master, did you ever write such mouldy little chapters! We do, to be sure, learn a few novelties from them: for example, that Gervinus has taught us how and why Goethe possessed no talent for the drama, that in the second part of Faust he has produced only a schematic allegory; that

Wallenstein is a Macbeth who is at the same time Hamlet;* that the Straussian reader plucks out the stories from the Wanderjahre in the way illbred children pluck the almonds and * 1 11 Schiller's three-pan drama H'(ll'11sll'll. 1 9 nil :: 1 9 I : :1 . 1 raisins out of a tough cake;'Ä that without thrills and extreme situations nothing on the stage can make any real effect; and that Schiller emerged from Kant as from a hydropathic establishment. All this is certainly new and striking, even if it does not strike us very pleasantly; and, as surely as it is new, just as surely it will never grow old, for it was never young: it came into the world already old. What ideas the new-style blessed come across in their aesthetic Heaven! And why have they not forgotten at any rate some of them, especially when they are as unaesthetic and earthly-ephemeral and bear the stamp of stupidity as visibly as, for example, some of the opinions of Gervinus! But it almost seems as though the modest greatness of a Strauss and the immodest minimality of a Gervinus can get on together only too well: and so hail to all these blessed ones, and hail to us unblessed ones as well, if this undoubted judge of art goes on teaching his acquired enthusiasm and his coach-horse gallop, of which honest Grillparzer has spoken with all due clarity, and all Heaven resounds with the hoofbeats' of this galloping enthusiasm! Things would at least be a bit livelier than they are at present, when the creeping carpet-slipped enthusiasm of our heavenly leader and the lukewarm eloquence of his mouth in the long run only weary and disgust us. I would like to know how a Hallelujah would sound in the mouth of Strauss: I imagine one would have to listen very closely or it would sound like a polite apology or a whispered compliment. I can relate an instructive and appalling example of this. Strauss took grave exception to references by one of his opponents to his bowing and scraping before Lessing- the unfortunate man had misunderstood him -; Strauss, to be sure, asserted that the man must be a numbskull not to recognize that the simple words he had used of Lessing in section got had come straight from the warmth of his heart. Now, I have no doubt at all as to the existence of this warmth; on the contrary, I have always felt that this warmth of approval of Lessing on the part of Strauss had something suspect about it; I find the same suspect approval of Lessing raised to steam heat in Gervinus; indeed, none of the great German writers is in general so popular with the little German writers as Lessing is; and yet they deserve no thanks for it: for what is it in Lessing that really wins their approval? First, his universality: he is a critic and a poet, an archaeologist and a philosopher, a theorist of drama and a *Goethe's novel Wilhelm Meisters Waruleryahre (1 82 1-9), which contains inset stories. t'section 90' refers to The Old Faith and the New. David Strauss; the confessor and the writer theologian. Then, 'this unity of the writer and the man, of the head and the heart'. The latter quality distinguishes every great writer, and sometimes even the little writer, for a narrow mind gets on fabulously well with a narrow heart. And the former

quality, universality, is in itself no distinction at all, especially as in Lessing's case it was a mere necessity. What is, rather, to be marvelled at in these Lessing enthusiasts is precisely that they fail to notice this consuming necessity which pursued Lessing throughout his life and forced upon him his 'universality'; that they fail to realize that such a man is consumed too quickly, like a flame, and are not indignant that this tender, ardent being was darkened, tormented and suffocated by the vulgar narrowness and poverty of his whole environment, and especially that of his learned contemporaries; that they fail to understand, indeed, that this admired universality is something that ought to evoke, not admiration, but a profound feeling of pity. 'Commiserate with the extraordinary man', Goethe cries to us, 'that he lived in so miserable' an age he had constantly to exert himself polemically.* How, my dear philistines, can you think of Lessing without a feeling of shame: he who perished of your stupidity, in conflict with your ludicrous totems and idols, through the wretched state of your theatres, your scholars, your theologians, without even once being able to venture that eternal flight for which he had come into the world. And what do you feel when you remember Winckelmann, who, to free his sight of your grotesque absurdities, went begging for help to the Jesuits and whose shameful conversion dishonours not him but you? Do you even dare to speak the name of Schiller and not blush? Look at this picture! The flashing eyes that gaze contemptuously out over your heads, the deathly flushed cheeks - do these say nothing to you? Here was a glorious, divine toy which you broke. And if this curtailed and mortally harassed life had been deprived of Goethe's friendship it would have been your part to extinguish it even sooner! None of your great geniuses has ever received any assistance from you, and do you now want to make it a dogma that none ever shall receive any? To each of them you were that 'resistance of the obtuse world' which Goethe names in his epilogue to Schiller's *Glocke*; to each of them you showed annoyance and lack of understanding, or envious narrow-mindedness, or malice and egoism: it was in spite of you they created their works, against you they directed their attacks, and it was thanks to you they "" Goethe to Eckermann, 7 February 1827. 2 1 p sank down too soon, their work unfinished, broken or deadened by the struggle. And are you now to be permitted, tamquam re bene gesta, * to praise such men! and to do so in words which reveal unmistakably whom it is you have in mind when you utter such praise, which then 'gushes so warmly from the heart' that one would have to be blind not to see towards whom your obeisances are really directed. Even in his day, Goethe felt impelled to exclaim: 'Truly, we are in need of a Lessing!' and woe to all vain teachers and to the whole aesthetic heavenly kingdom if the young tiger, his restless energy visible in swelling muscles and the glance of his eye, should ever set out in search of prey! How wise my friend was that, enlightened by this chimerical figure as to the nature of the Straussian Lessing and of Strauss himself, he

forbore to read further. We read further, however, and went on to beg entry into the musical sanctum of p new faith. The Master opened the door, attended at our side, explained, named names - at last we stopped mistrustfully and looked at him: were we not experiencing the .same thing as happened to our poor friend in his dream? So long as he was speaking of them, the composers of whom Strauss spoke seemed to us to be wrongly named, and we felt he must be referring to someone else, if not to mere teasing phantoms. When, for example, he takes, with the same warmth as had made us suspicious when he praised Lessing, the name of Haydn into his mouth and gives himself out for an epopt and priest of a Haydnesque mystery cult, while at the same time (p. 362) comparing Haydn with 'honest soup' and Beethoven with 'confectionary' (in reference to the quartets, of all things), we are certain of only one thing: his co nfectio nary-Beethoven is not our Beethoven, and his soup-Haydn is not our Haydn. The Master finds, moreover, that our orchestras are too good to perform his Haydn and believes that this music is suited only to the most modestly competent dilettanti - again a proof that he is referring to a different artist and to different works of art (perhaps to Riehl's music for the home). But who could this Straussian confectio nary-Beethoven be? He is supposed to have written nine symphonies, of which the 'Pastoral' is 'the least inspired'; we discover that at every third of them he is *tamquam re bene gesta: as if things had turned out well David Strauss, the confessor and the writer impelled 'to kick over the traces and go off on an adventure', which almost suggests to us a cross-bred creature, half horse, half knight errant. In regard to a certain 'Eroica' it is seriously stated of this cen taur that he has failed to make it clear 'whether what is going on is a conflict on the batdefield or in the depths of the human heart'. hi the 'Pastoral' there is an 'excellent storm' which is, however, far too good to interrupt a mere peasants' dance; and it is through this 'capricious continual association' of the music with its 'trivial underlying oc casion', as Strauss so neady and correctly calls it, that this symphony is 'the least inspired' - an even harsher word seems to have hovered in the mind of our classical Master but, as he tells us, he preferred to express himself here 'with befitting modesty'. But no, here he is for once in the wrong, here he really is too modest. For who else is to instruct us about the confectionary-Beethoven if not Strauss himself, the only one who seems to know him? There immediately follows, moreover, the enunciation of a firm and befittingly immodest judg ment, this time on the Ninth Symphony: this work, it seems, may be loved only by those to whom 'the baroque counts as a mark of genius and the formless as the sublime' (p. 359) . It is true that so stern a critic as Gervinus gave it a welcome, namely as a confirmation of one of his own dogmas: he, Strauss, is however very far from seeking the merits of his Beethoven in such 'problematic productions'. 'It is a pity', sighs our Master sadly, 'that our enjoyment of Beethoven and the admiration we gladly accord him must

be diminished by reservations of this kind.' For our Master is a favourite of the muses, and they have told him that they went only a stretch of the way with Beethoven and that he thereafter again lost sight of them. 'This is a defect', he cries, 'but can one believe that it also appears as a merit?' 'He who trundles along the musical idea with toil and out of breath will appear to be the stronger and to move what is heavier' (pp. 355- 6). This is a confession, and in regard not only to Beethoven but to the 'classic prose-writer' himself: the muses never let go of him, the celebrated author: from the lightest play of wit - Straussian wit, that is - to the heights of seriousness - Straussian seriousness, that is - they stay imperturbably at his side. He, the classic artist in writing, carries his burden with playful ease, while Beethoven trundles his along out of breath. He seems to dally with his load: there is a merit; but can one believe that it might appear as a defect? - But at the most only to those to whom the baroque counts as a mark of genius and the formless as the sublime - is that not so, you dallying favourite of the muses? We begrudge no one the edification he acquires for himself in the silence of his room or in the new heavenly kingdom arranged for the purpose; but of all possible forms of edification the Straussian is one of the strangest; for he edifies himself at a little sacrificial fire into which he casually casts the sublimest works of the German nation in order to perfume his idols with the smoke they produce. Let us imagine for a moment that the 'Eroica', the 'Pastoral' and the Ninth had chanced to get into the hands of our priest of the muses and that it had then depended upon him to keep Beethoven's image spotless through the removal of such 'problematical productions' who can doubt that he would have burned them? And that is how the Strausses of our day in fact proceed: they want to know of an artist only that by which he is suited for their domestic service, and can see no alternative but using him as perfume or burning him. This, of course, they should be at liberty to do: the only strange thing about it is that public opinion in aesthetic matters is so insipid, uncertain and easily misled that it beholds such an exhibition of the sorriest philistinism without protest, that it lacks, indeed, any feeling for the comicality of a scene in which an unaesthetic magistrate sits in judgment on Beethoven. And as for Mozart, there ought truly to apply to him what Aristotle said of Plato: 'the bad man is not permitted even to praise him'. Here, however, all shame has been lost, on the part of the public as much as on that of the Master; not only is he permitted to cross himself before the greatest and purest products of the German genius as though he had beheld something godless and indecent, but his candid confessions of sins are received with delight, especially as he confesses not sins he himself has committed, but those supposedly committed by our great spirits. 'Ah, if only our Master really was always right!' his admiring readers sometimes think in an access of doubt; he himself, however, stands there, smiling and certain, perorating, damning and blessing, doffing his hat to himself, and capable at any moment of saying what

the duchess Delafone said to Madame de Stael: 'I have to admit, my dear friend, that I know of nobody who is always right except me.' To the worm a corpse is a pleasant thought, and to everything living a worm is a dreadful one. The worm's idea of Heaven is a fat carcass, the philosophy professor's is grubbing about in the entrails of Schopenhauer, and as long as there are rats there will also be a rat David Strauss the confessor and the writer Heaven. This provides the answer to our first question: how does the new believer imagine his Heaven? The Straussian philistine lodges in the works of our great poets and composers like a worm which lives by destroying, admires by consuming, reveres by digesting. Now we come to our second question: how far does -the courage bestowed on him by the new faith extend? This too would already have been answered if courage were identical with immodesty: for in that case Strauss would possess the courage of a Mameluke - for that befitting modesty of which he speaks in the passage on Beethoven just alluded to is only a stylistic device, not a moral position. Strauss has sufficient of that impudence to which every victorious hero feels himself entitled; every flower that blooms belongs to him, the victor, alone, and he lauds the sun for illuminating his window. Even the ancient, venerable universe does not remain untouched by his commendations, as though they alone could consecrate it and it must . henceforth revolve only about the central monad, Strauss. The universe, he informs us; is a machine with iron wheels and cogs and heavy pistons and rams, 'but merciless cogs are not all that move within it, there also flows a soothing oil' (p. 365). The universe will not be precisely grateful to our image-mad Master that he can find no better metaphor with which to commend it, if indeed it takes any pleasure at all in being commended by Strauss. What is this oil called which trickles down on to the pistons and rams? And of what consolation could it be to the worker within this machine to know that this oil is being poured on to him while the machine continues to hold him in its grip? Let us say simply that the metaphor is an unfortunate one and turn our attention to another procedure through which Strauss seeks to convey how he really feels towards the universe and in the course of which there hovers upon his lips the question Gretchen kept asking: 'He loves me - he loves me not - he loves me?''* If while he is doing this Strauss does not pluck the petals from a flower or count the buttons on a coat, what he does do is no less harmless, though it perhaps requires a little more courage. Strauss wants to see whether or not his feeling for the 'cosmos' has become paralysed and dead, and he jabs himself: for he knows that one can jab one's arm with a needle quite painlessly so long as the arm is paralysed and dead. In reality, to be sure, he does not jab himself, he chooses an even more violent procedure, which he describes thus: 'We open Schopenhauer, who loses no opportunity of striking >IOIn Goethe's Faust, Part I Scene 1 2. our idea in the face' (p. 1 43). But since it is not an idea, even the fairest Straussian idea of the universe, that has a face, but he who has the idea,

the procedure here described consists of the following individual acts: Strauss opens Schopenhauer, whereupon Schopenhauer takes the opportunity to strike Strauss in the face. Strauss now 'reacts', and does so 'religiously', that is to say he strikes back at Schopenhauer, berates him, speaks of absurdities, blasphemies, infamies, even asserts that Schopenhauer was out of his mind. The outcome of this cudgelling: 'we demand for our universe the same piety as the devout of the old stamp do for their God' - more briefly: 'he loves me!' He makes things hard for himself, our favourite of the muses, but he is as brave as a Mameluke and fears neither the Devil nor Schopenhauer. How much 'soothing oil' would he not use up if he indulged in such procedures very often! On the other hand, we realize the debt Strauss actually owes to the titillating, jabbing and cudgelling Schopenhauer; and the following express act of kindness towards him thereby fails to occasion in us any further surprise. 'It is necessary only to leaf through Arthur Schopenhauer's writings, though one would also do well, not merely to leaf through them, but to study them' etc. (p. 141). To whom is the chieftain of the philistines really addressing these words? - he of whom it can be proved that he has never studied Schopenhauer, he of whom Schopenhauer himself would have to have said: 'this is an author who does not deserve to be leafed through, let alone studied'. It is obvious that he swallowed Schopenhauer the wrong way: by coughing and spluttering he is trying to get rid of him. But so that the measure of naive commendation shall be full, Strauss permits himself to recommend old Kant: he calls Kant's *Allgemeine Geschichte und Theorie des Himmels* of 1755 'a work which has always seemed to me no less significant than his later critique of reason. If in the latter what one must admire is profundity of insight, in the former it is extensiveness of outlook; if in the latter we see the aged philosopher engaged in securing a domain of knowledge, even if a limited one, in the former we encounter a man filled with all the courage of the spiritual discoverer and conqueror.' This judgment of Kant on the part of Strauss has always seemed to me no more modest than his judgment of Schopenhauer: if in the latter we see the chieftain engaged above all in securing the expression of a judgment, albeit a very limited one, in the former we encounter the celebrated prose writer who, with all the courage of ignorance, empties his vial of David Strauss, the confessor and the writer commendation even upon Kant. The quite incredible fact that Strauss has no notion how to derive from Kant's critique of reason support for his testament of modern ideas, and that everywhere he flatters nothing but the crudest kind of realism, is among the most striking characteristics of this new gospel, which presents itself moreover only as the arduously attained outcome of continuous historical and scientific research and therewith denies any involvement with philosophy at all. For the philistine chieftain and his 'we' there is no such thing as the Kantian philosophy. He has no notion of the fundamental antinomies of idealism or of the extreme relativity of all science and

reason. Or: it is precisely reason that ought to tell him how little of the in-itself of things can be determined by reason. But it is true that people of a certain age find it impossible to understand Kant, especially if in their youth they have, like Strauss, understood, or thought they understood, the 'gigantic spirit' Hegel, and have also had to occupy themselves with Schleiermacher, 'who', as Strauss says, 'possessed almost too much acuteness'. It will sound strange to Strauss when I tell him that even now he is in a state of 'absolute dependence' on Hegel and Schleiermacher, and that his doctrine of the universe, his way of regarding things *sub specie bienni*, * his grovelling before the realities of present-day Germany, above all his shameless philistine optimism, are to be elucidated by reference to certain early youthful impressions, habits and pathological phenomena. He who has once contracted Hegelism and Schleiermacherism is never quite cured of them. There is one passage in the confessional book in which this in curable optimism goes strolling along with a downright holiday air of complacency (pp. 1 42-3). 'If the world is a thing that it were better did not exist', says Strauss, 'well then, the thought of the philosopher, which constitutes a piece of this world, is a thought that it were better was not thought. The pessimistic philosopher does not see that he declares his own thought bad when his thought declares the world bad; but if a thought which declares the world bad is itself bad thinking, then the world is, on the contrary, good. Optimism may as a rule make things too easy for itself, and here Schopenhauer's insistence on the role which pain and evil play in the world is quite in order; but every true philosophy is necessarily optimistic, since otherwise it denies its own right to exist.' If this refutation of Schopenhauer is not "*sub specie bienni*: literally, 'under the aspect of two years' - Nietzsche's ironic adaptation of the well-known phrase '*sub specie aeternitatis*'. the same as that which in another place Strauss calls a 'refutation to the loud rejoicing of the higher spheres', then I do not understand this theatrical expression, which he once employed against an opponent. Optimism has here for once deliberately made things too easy for itself. But the trick of the thing was precisely to make it look as though refuting Schopenhauer was no bother at all and to cast one's burden off with such playful ease that the three muses would take continual delight in the dallying optimist. This is to be achieved by showing that there is no need whatever to take a pessimist seriously: the vainest sophistries will do for dealing with so 'unhealthy and unprofitable' a philosophy as Schopenhauer's, upon which one needs to expend, not reasons, but at the most jokes and phrases. In the light of such passages as this, one comprehends Schopenhauer's solemn assertion that, where it is not the thought less chatter of those beneath whose flat cranium there are no thoughts but only words, optimism seems to him not merely an absurd but also a truly infamous mode of thinking, a bitter mockery of the nameless sufferings of mankind. When the philistine reduces it to a system, as Strauss does, he also reduces it to an infamous mode of thinking, that is to say to

an inordinately stupid ease-and contentment doctrine for the benefit of the 'ego', or of his 'we', and he arouses indignation. Who, for example, could read the following psychological elucidation without feeling indignation, since it can quite clearly have sprung only from the stem of this infamous ease-and contentment theory: 'Beethoven said he would never have been able to compose such a text as Figaro or Don Giovanni. Life had not smiled upon him to the extent that he could have adopted so cheerful a view of it as to take the weaknesses of mankind so lightly' (p. 36 1). But the worst example of this infamous vulgarity of mind is supplied in the fact that Strauss knows no other way of explaining to himself the whole dreadfully serious drive to self-abnegation and to salvation in asceticism evidenced in the first centuries of Christianity than by supposing it to have originated in a preceding surfeit of sexual indulgence of all kinds and the disgust and nausea that resulted: 'The Persians call it bidamag buden, The Gennans say Katzenjammer.' * Strauss himself quotes these lines and is not ashamed. We, however, turn aside for a moment to overcome our disgust. « Katzenjammer: a hangover; remorse for the previous night's debauch. The couplet is from Goethe's West-östlicher Divan. David Strauss, the confessor and the writer Our philistine chieftain is indeed brave with words to the point of rashness whenever he believes he will give delight to his noble 'we' through such bravery. Thus, the asceticism and self-abnegation of the saints and hermits of old may count as a form of Katzenjammer, Jesus may be described as a visionary who would in our day hardly escape the madhouse, the story of the resurrection may be called a 'piece of world-historical humbug' - let us for once let all this pass, so that we may study the singular courage of which Strauss, our 'classic philistine', is capable. Let us first hear his confession: 'To tell the world what it least wants to hear is, to be sure, a displeasing and thankless office. It likes to live unstintingly, like a great lord, it receives and pays out for as long as it has anything to pay with: but when someone comes along to reckon up the items and hands it the bill, it regards him as a mischief-maker. And precisely that is what my head and heart have always impelled me to do.' Such a head and heart may well be called courageous, yet it remains doubtful whether this courage is natural and original, or whether it is not rather acquired and artificial; perhaps Strauss accustomed himself to being a mischief-maker by profession only gradually, until he had acquired from this profession the courage for it. That would accord very well with natural cowardice, such as is proper to the philistine: it reveals itself especially in the inconsequentiality of those assertions which it takes courage to make; there is the sound of thunder, but there follows no clearing of the air. He cannot manage an aggressive act, only aggressive words, but he chooses the most offensive words he can find and exhausts all his force and energy in uncouth and blustering expressions: when his words have died away he is more cowardly than

he who has never spoken. Even the phantom form of actions, ethics, reveals that he is a hero only of words, and that he avoids every occasion on which it is necessary to proceed from words to grim earnest. He announces with admirable frankness that he is no longer a Christian, but he does not wish to disturb anyone's peace of mind; it seems to him contradictory to found an association in order to overthrow an association - which is in fact not so very contradictory. With a certain rude contentment he covers himself in the hairy cloak of our apes - genealogists and praises Darwin as one of the greatest benefactors of mankind - but it confuses us to see that his ethics are constructed entirely independently of the question: 'What is our conception of the world?' Here was an opportunity to exhibit native courage: for here he ought to have turned his back on his 'we' and boldly derived a moral code for life out of the bellum omnium contra omnes * and the privileges of the strong - though such a code would, to be sure, have to originate in an intrepid mind such as that of Hobbes, and in a grand love of truth quite different from that which explodes only in angry outbursts against priests, miracles and the 'world historical humbug' of the resurrection. For with a genuine Darwinian ethic, seriously and consistently carried through, he would have had against him the philistine whom with such outbursts he attracts to his side. 'All moral behaviour' says Strauss, 'is a self-determination of the individual according to the idea of the species.' Translated into comprehensible language, all this means is: Live as a man and not as an ape or a seal! Unfortunately this imperative is altogether without force and useless, because the concept of man yokes together the most diverse and manifold things, for example the Patagonian and Master Strauss, and because no one will venture to demand: 'Live as a Patagonian!' and at the same time 'Live as Master Strauss!' If, however, anyone should go so far as to demand of himself: 'Live as a genius', that is to say as the ideal expression of the species man, but happened to be either a Patagonian or Master Strauss, how we would then have to suffer from the importunities of natural fools thirsting for genius. Lichtenberg in his day already had to complain of their mushroom-like growth in Germany - and demanding of us with wild cries that we listen to their latest confessions of faith. Strauss has not yet even learned that no idea can ever make men better or more moral, and that preaching morals is as easy as finding grounds for them is difficult; his task was much rather to take the phenomena of human goodness, compassion, love and self-abnegation, which do in fact exist, and derive and explain them from his Darwinist pre-suppositions: while he preferred by a leap into the imperative to flee from the task of explanation. In making this leap he is even able to elude, with an easy and frivolous hop, Darwin's fundamental proposition. 'Do not ever forget', says Strauss, 'that you are a man and not a mere creature of nature: do not ever forget that all others are likewise men, that is to say, with all their individual differences the same as you, with the same needs and demands as you that is the

epitome of all morality.' But whence sounds this imperative? How can man possess it in himself, since, according to DaIWin, he is pre- "bellum omnium contra omnes: war of all against all David Strauss, the confessor and the writer cisely a creature of nature and nothing else, and has evolved to the height of being man by quite other laws: precisely, in fact, by always forgetting that other creatures similar to him possessed equivalent rights, precisely by feeling himself the stronger and gradually eliminating the other, weaker examples of his species? While Strauss is obliged to assume that no two creatures have been exactly similar, and that the entire evolution of man from the level of the animals up to the heights of the cultural philistine depends upon the law of dif ferences between individuals, he finds no difficulty in enunciating the opposite: 'behave as though there were no differences between individuals!' Where has the moral teaching of Strauss-Darwin now gone, where has any courage whatever gone! We are at once given a fresh demonstration of the point at which courage is transposed into its opposite. For Strauss continues: 'Do not ever forget that you and all that you are aware of within and around you is no disconnected fragment, no wild chaos of atoms and accidents, but that 'everything proceeds according to eternal laws out of the one primeval source of all life, all reason and all good ness that is the epitome of religion.' Out of this 'one primeval source' however, there at the same time flows all destruction, all unreason, all evil, and Strauss calls this source the universe. But how, given it possesses so contradictory and self-annulling a character, should this be worthy of religious veneration and be addressed by the name 'God', as Strauss himself addresses it (p. 365): 'our God does not take us into his arms from outside' - here one expects as an antithesis a certainly very strange 'taking us into his arms from within'! - 'he opens to us sources of consolation within us. He shows us that, while chance would be an irrational master of the world, necessity, i.e. the chain of causes in the world, is reason itself' (a piece of surreptitiousness which only the 'we' can fail to recognize as such because they were raised in this Hegelian worship of the real as the rational, that is to say in the deiflCation of success). 'He teaches us to see that to desire an exception to the fulfilment of a single law of nature would be to desire the destruction of the cosmos.' On the contrary, Master: an honest natural scientist believes that the world conforms unconditionally to laws, without however asserting anything as to the ethical or intellectual value of these laws: he would regard any such assertions as the extreme anthropomorphism of a reason that has overstepped the bounds of the permitted. But it is at precisely the point at which the honest natural scientist resigns that Strauss 'reacts' -in order to plume us with his feathers -'religiously' , and goes on to 3 1 pursue a consciously dishonest kind of natural science;'he assumes without question that all events possess the highest intellectual value and are thus absolutely rational and purposeful, and then that they contain a revelation of eternal goodness itself. He

is thus in need of a complete cosmodicy and at a disadvantage compared with those who are concerned only with a theodicy, who conceive the entire existence of man as, for example, a punishment or a process of purification. At this point, and thus embarrassed, Strauss goes so far as to venture for once a metaphysical hypothesis - the driest and most palsied there has ever been and at bottom no more than an unconscious parody of a saying of Lessing's. 'That other saying of Lessing's', he says on page 219, 'that, if God held all truth in his right hand and in his left the never-sleeping quest for truth with the condition of continually erring in this quest, and then offered him a choice between them, he would humbly fall upon God's left hand and beg for the contents of it - this saying has always been regarded as among the finest he left to us. There has been found in it an expression of his restless desire for action and investigation. This saying has always made so powerful an impression upon me because behind its subjective significance I have heard resounding an objective one of immense range. For does it not contain the best reply to Schopenhauer's crude conception of an ill-advised God who knows of nothing better to do than to enter into so wretched a world as this is? May it not be that the Creator himself shares Lessing's opinion and prefers continual striving to peaceful possession?' A God, that is to say, who reserves to himself continual error and at the same time a striving for truth, and who perhaps humbly falls upon Strauss's left hand and says to him: all truth is for you. If ever a God or a man were ill-advised it is this Straussian God, with his partiality for error and failure, and the Straussian man, who has to pay for this partiality here indeed one can 'hear resounding a significance of immense range', here there flows Strauss's universal soothing oil, here one senses something of the rationality of all evolution and natural law! Does one really? Or would our world not be, rather, as Lichtenberg once called it, the work of a subordinate being who as yet lacked a full understanding of his task, and thus an experiment? a novice's test-piece which was still being worked on? So that Strauss himself would have to concede that our world is an arena, not of rationality, but of error, and that its laws and purposefulness are no source of consolation, since they proceed from a God who is not merely in error but takes pleasure in being in error. It is a truly delicious spectacle - David Strauss, the confessor and the writer tattle to behold Strauss as a metaphysical architect building up into the clouds. But for whom is this spectacle mounted? For the noble and contented 'we', so as to preserve their contentment: perhaps they were overcome by fear in the midst of those merciless wheels of the universal machine and tremblingly begged their leader for help. Whereupon Strauss started the 'soothing oil' flowing, led on a God who errs out of a passion for error, and assumed for once the wholly uncongenial role of a metaphysical architect. He does all this because his 'we' are afraid and he himself is afraid - and here we discover the limits of his courage, even with respect to his 'we'. For he does not dare to tell them honestly: I have

liberated you from a helpful and merciful God, the universe is only a rigid machine, take care you are not mangled in its wheels! This he dares not do: so he has to call in the sorceress, that is to say metaphysics. To the philistine, however, even a Straussian metaphysic is preferable to the Christian, and the idea of an erring God more attractive than that of a miracle-working one. For he himself, the philistine, commits errors, but has never yet performed a miracle. It is for this very reason that the philistine hates the genius: for the genius has the justified reputation of performing miracles; and that is why it is in the highest degree instructive to see why, in one solitary passage, Strauss for once presents himself as the daring defender of the genius and of the aristocratic natures of the spirit. Why does he do it? From fear, this time fear of the social democrats. He refers them to Bismarck, Moltke, 'whose greatness can be the less denied as they advance into the realm of palpable action. Now even the most stiff-necked and surly of these fellows must be constrained to look upwards a little, so as to get a sight of these exalted figures, even if only to the knee.' Do you perhaps desire, Master, to give the social democrats instruction in how to get kicked? The will to deliver such kicks is to be found everywhere, after all, and that those who are to get kicked can see only 'to the knee' of these exalted figures seems to ensure that the kicks will be successfully delivered. 'In the domain of art and science too', Strauss goes on, 'there will never be a lack of kings who build and who give work to a host of carters.' Good - but suppose the carters themselves start to build? It does happen, metaphysical Master, you know that - then the kings will have to grin and bear it. This union of audacity and weakness, of rash words and cowardly acquiescence, this subtle assessment of how and with what expressions one can now impress the philistine, now flatter him, this I I I lack of character and strength masquerading as strength and character, this defectiveness in wisdom with the affectation of superiority and mature experience- all this, in fact, is what I hate in this book. If I thought that young men could endure such a book, even treasure it, I would sadly renounce all hope for their future. This confession of a pitiful, hopeless and truly contemptible philistinism presents itself as an expression of the views of those many thousands of 'we's of whom Strauss speaks, and these 'we's are in turn the fathers of the coming generation! These are gruesome presuppositions for anyone who wants to assist the coming generation to that which the present does not possess - to a truly German culture. To such a one the ground seems strewn with ashes and all the stars appear obscured; every dead tree, every desolate field cries to him: Unfruitful! Lost! Here there will be no more spring! He has to feel as the youthful Goethe felt when he looked into the sad atheistical twilight of the *Systeme de la nature*: the book seemed to him so Cimmerian, so stagnant, so dead, that it cost him an effort to endure its proximity, and he shuddered in its presence as in the presence of a ghost. ::< We are now sufficiently instructed as

to the new believer's Heaven and his courage to be able to pose our final question: how does he write his books? and what is the nature of the scriptures of his religion? To him who can answer this question rigorously and without prejudice, the fact that Strauss's portable oracle for the German philistine has been in demand to the extent of six editions will present a problem of the most thought-provoking kind, especially when he hears that it has also received a warm welcome in scholarly circles and even in German universities. Students are said to have greeted it as a syllabus for the training of strong minds and professors are said not to have objected: here and there the book has been received as a sacred scripture for scholars. Strauss himself gives us to understand that the confessional book is not intended to offer instruction only to scholars and the cultivated, but we adhere to the view that it is directed at these in the first instance, and particularly at the scholars, "Systeme de La nature: Baron d'Holbach's once celebrated defence of atheistic materialism and determinism, published in 1770. Goethe refers to it in *Dichtung und Wahrheit* III. David Strauss, the confessor and the writer and that it holds up to them the reflection of a life such as they themselves live. For this is the trick of the thing: the Master affects to be outdining the ideal of a new philosophy of life, and now he hears himself praised on every side, since everyone is in a position to think that this is precisely how he thinks and that Strauss would see already fulfilled in him that which he has demanded only of the future. This is part of the explanation of the extraordinary success of this book: 'as is here written so do we live and go our way rejoicing!' the scholar cries to him, and is glad when he finds that others feel the same. Whether he happens to differ from the Master on individual points over DaWin, for example, or capital punishment - is to him of little moment, since he is on the whole so certain of breathing his own air and hearing the echo of his voice and his needs. The painfulness of this unanimity for any true friend of German culture must not deter him from acknowledging it to himself or from making the fact public. We all know how our age is typified by its pursuit of science; we know it because it is part of our life: and that precisely is the reason almost no one asks himself what the consequences of such an involvement with the sciences could be for culture, even supposing that the will and the capacity to promote culture were everywhere to hand. For the nature of scientific man (quite apart from the form he assumes at present) contains a real paradox: he behaves like the proudest idler of fortune, as though existence were not a dreadful and questionable thing but a firm possession guaranteed to last for ever. He seems to be permitted to squander his life on questions whose answer could at bottom be of consequence only to someone assured of an eternity. The heir of but a few hours, he is ringed around with frightful abysses, and every step he takes ought to make him ask: Whither? Whence? To what end? But his soul is warmed with the task of counting the stamens of a flower or breaking up the stones of the

pathway, and all the interest, joy, strength and desire he possesses is absorbed in this work. Now, this paradox, the scientific man, has in recent years got into a frantic hurry in Germany, as though science were a factory and every minute's slacking incurred punishment. Nowadays he works as hard as the fourth estate, the slaves; his study is no longer an occupation but a necessity, he looks neither to right nor left and goes through all the business of life, and its more questionable aspects, with the half-consciousness or the repellent need for entertainment characteristic of the exhausted worker. Now this is his attitude towards culture too. He behaves as though life were to him only *otium sine dignitate*: and even in his dreams he does not throw off his yoke, like a slave who even when freed still dreams of servitude and beatings. Our scholars are hardly to be distinguished - and then not to their advantage - from farmers who want to increase the tiny property they have inherited and are assiduously employed all day and far into the night in tilling the field, leading the plough and encouraging the oxen. Now, Pascal believes quite generally that men pursue their business and their sciences so eagerly only so as to elude the most important questions which would press upon them in a state of solitude or if they were truly idle, that is to say precisely those questions as to Whither, Whence and Why. Amazingly, the most obvious question fails to occur to our scholars: what is their work, their hurry, their painful frenzy supposed to be for? To earn bread or acquire positions of honour, perhaps? Not at all. Yet you exert yourselves like those in need of food, indeed you tear it from the table of science as greedily and as utterly unselectively as though you were on the point of starvation. But if you, as men of science, treat science in the way a worker treats the tasks that are to furnish his means of life, what will become of a culture condemned to await the hour of its birth and redemption in the midst of such excitement and breathless confusion? No one has time for it - and yet what is science for at all if it has no time for culture? At least reply to this question: what is the Whence, Whither, To what end of science if it is not to lead to culture? To lead to barbarism, perhaps? That our learned class has already gone frighteningly far in this direction is evident when we think that such superficial books as Strauss's are sufficient to meet the demands of their present cultural level. For it is precisely in such books that we find that repellent need for entertainment and that casual, only-half listening accommodation with philosophy and culture and with the serious things of life in general. One is reminded of the social world of the learned classes, where too, when the shop talk is exhausted, there is evidence only of weariness, of a desire for diversion at any price, of a tattered memory and incoherent personal experience. When we hear Strauss speak of the problems of life - whether it be the problem of marriage or of war or of capital punishment - we are appalled at his lack of real experience, of any native insight into the nature of man: all his judgments are so uniformly bookish, indeed at "*otium sine*

dignitate: idleness without dignity David Strauss, the confessor and the writer bottom merely of the sort found in the newspapers; literary remissions take the place of genuine ideas and insights, an affected moderation and knowingness is supposed to compensate us for the lack of real wisdom and maturity of thought. How exactly this corresponds to the spirit which informs the noisily advertised high seats of learning in the cities of Germany! How congenial this spirit must find the spirit of Strauss: for it is in precisely those places that culture is most completely lacking, it is precisely there that the germination of a new culture is totally thwarted; noisy preparation for the sciences there pursued goes with a herdlike stampede for the disciplines most in favour at the cost of deserting those of most consequence. With what kind of lantern would one have to search here for men capable of inward contemplation and an undivided devotion to the genius and possessing the strength and courage to conjure up demons which have deserted our age! Viewed externally, these places display all the pomp of culture, with their imposing apparatus they resemble an arsenal choked with cannon and other weapons of war: we behold such preparations and industrious activity as though Heaven itself were to be stormed and truth fetched up out of the deepest well, and yet in warfare it is often the biggest pieces of apparatus that are worst deployed. Genuine culture likewise avoids these places as it conducts its campaigns, feeling instinctively that it has nothing to hope for and much to fear in them. For the only form of culture with which the inflamed eye and the blunted brain of the learned working class want to occupy themselves is precisely that philistine culture whose gospel has been proclaimed by Strauss. If we consider for a moment the principal grounds of that congeniality which links the learned working class and philistine culture we shall also discover the path that leads us to our final main theme: consideration of Strauss as a writer recognized as a classic. In the first place, this culture wears an expression of complacency and will have nothing essential changed in the present condition of German education; it is above all seriously convinced of the superiority of all German educational institutions, especially the grammar schools and universities, never ceases to recommend them to foreigners as models, and does not doubt for a moment that they have made the German people into the most educated and judicious nation in the world. Philistine culture believes in itself and therefore in the means and methods available to it. In the second place, however, it lays the final arbitration as to all questions' of taste and culture in the hands of the scholar and regards itself as an ever-growing compendium of learned opinions on art, literature and philosophy; it is concerned to constrain the scholar to express his opinions and then to administer them to the German people, admixed, diluted or systematized, as a medicinal draught. Whatever may develop outside this circle is listened to with doubt and inattentively, or not listened to at all, until at length a single voice, no matter

whose it may be so long as it bears the firm stamp of the scholarly species, is heard from within those sacred halls where the traditional infallibility in matters of taste is supposed to dwell: and from then on public opinion possesses one opinion more and repeats this single voice with a hundredfold echo. In reality, however, this supposed aesthetic infallibility is very questionable, so questionable indeed that one may assume that a scholar in fact lacks taste, ideas and aesthetic judgment until he has demonstrated the opposite. And only a few will be able to do so. For, after the panting and harassment of the daily race which the world of the sciences is today, how many of them will be able to maintain that courageous and steady glance that characterizes the champion of culture even if they ever possessed it - that glance which condemns this daily race itself as a source of barbarism? That is why these few must, moreover, live in a state of opposition: what can they achieve against the uniform belief of countless thousands who have one and all made of public opinion their patron saint and who sustain and support one another in this belief? Of what good is it for an individual to declare himself against Strauss when the many have decided in his favour and the masses they lead have learned to thirst for repeated draughts of the Master's philistine sleeping-potion? If we have herewith assumed without further ado that the Straussian confessional book has scored a victory with public opinion and has been welcomed as a victor, its author may perhaps draw our attention to the fact that the diverse judgments on his book in the public prints are by no means unanimous and certainly not uniformly favourable, and that he himself has had to protest in a postscript against the sometimes extremely hostile tone and impudent and challenging manner of some of these newspaper warriors. How can there be one public opinion about my book, he will expostulate, when every journalist regards me as fair game, an outlaw to be mis-handled at will! This contradiction is easily resolved as soon as we distinguish between two aspects of the Straussian book, the theological and the literary: it is only in the latter aspect that the book impinges on German culture. Through its theological colouring it David Strauss the confessor and the writer stands outside our German culture and awakens the antipathy of the various theological parties, indeed of every individual German insofar as he is a theological sectarian by nature and invents his own strange private theology so as to be able to dissent from every other. But just hear all these theological sectarians as soon as Strauss is spoken of as a writer; at once the theological dissonances die away and we hear in the purest unison as though from the mouth of one community: nonetheless he is a classic writer! Now everyone, even the most sullenly orthodox, flatters Strauss to his face as a writer, though it may be no more than a word in commendation of his almost Lessing-like dialectics or the freedom, beauty and validity of his aesthetic views. As a book, it seems, the Straussian production corresponds exactly to the ideal of a book. His theological

opponents, though they spoke loudest, are in this case only a small fragment of the great public: and even in relation to them Strauss is right when he says: 'Compared with my thousands of readers, my couple of dozen detractors are a vanishing minority, and it will be hard for them to prove that they are faithful interpreters of the former. If, in such a matter as this is, those who disagree have spoken up, while those who agree have contented themselves with silent approval, that lies in the nature of the casM.' Apart from the scandal which Strauss may here and there have provoked among the theological confessions, as to Strauss the writer there thus reigns unanimity even among his fanatical opponents to whom his voice is like the voice of the beast from the abyss. And the treatment Strauss has received at the hands of the literary day-labourers of the theological parties therefore proves nothing against our proposition that in this book philistine culture .has celebrated a triumph. It must be admitted that the educated philistine is on average a degree less candid than Strauss, or at least is more reserved when he speaks publicly: but candour in another is therefore all the more edifying for him; at home and among his own kind he loudly applauds it, and it is only in writing that he declines to confess how much all that Strauss says is after his own heart. For, as we already know, our culture philistine is somewhat cowardly, even when he is strongly moved: and it is precisely the fact that Strauss is a degree less cowardly that makes him a leader, while on the other hand there are very definite limits to his courage. If he were to overstep these limits, as Schopenhauer for instance does with almost every sentence, he would no longer lead on the philistines as their chieftain but would be deserted as precipitately as he is now followed. If anyone thought to call this moderation and mediocrity in courage, which if not wise is at any rate prudent, an Aristotelean virtue he would be in error: for this species of courage is the mean, not between two faults, but between a fault and a virtue and it is within this mean between virtue and fault that all the qualities of the philistine lie. 'But nonetheless he is a classic writer!' We shall now see. It might perhaps be in order to go on to speak of Strauss the stylist and artist in language, but let us first of all consider whether as a writer he is capable of constructing his house, whether he really understands the architecture of a book. This will determine whether he is a genuine, thoughtful and practised maker of books; and if we have to answer in the negative, his fame can always take refuge in his claim to be a 'classic writer of prose'. The latter capacity without the former would, to .be sure, not suffice to raise him to the rank of a classic author, but at best to that of the clōsic improvisers or virtuosi of style who, with all their skill in expression, reveal in the actual erection of the building the clumsy hand and ignorant eye of the bungler. We shall therefore ask whether Strauss possesses the artistic power to construct a whole, totum ponere. * As a rule the first written draft suffices to show whether the author has envisaged his work as a whole and found the

general tell!po and correct proportions appropriate to what he has envisaged. If this most vital of tasks has been achieved and the building itself erected . with proper scale and balance, there nonetheless remains a great deal still to do: how many minor errors must be corrected, how many holes stopped, here and there a provisional partition or a false floor must be replaced, dust and rubble lie everywhere, and wherever you look you can see signs of the labour that has been going on; the house as a whole is still uninhabitable and uncomfortable: all the walls are bare and the wind whistles through the open windows. Whether Strauss has done the great and wearisome work now needed will not concern us very long when we ask if he has produced the building itself in fair proportions and visualized it as a whole. The opposite of this, to put a book together out of bits and pieces, is well known to be the way of scholars. They trust that these bits and pieces will cohere of themselves and thereby confuse logical **totum ponere*: to construct a whole (repeating previous phrase) David Strauss, the confessor and the writer cohesion with artistic. In any event, the relation between the four main questions which designate the divisions of Strauss's book is not logical: 'Are we still Christians? Do we still possess religion? How do we conceive the world? How do we order our life?', and their relation is not logical because the third question has nothing to do with the second, the fourth nothing to do with the third, and all three have nothing to do with the first. The natural scientist, for example, who poses the third question, demonstrates the immaculateness of his sense for truth precisely in that he passes by the second in silence; and that the themes of the fourth section - marriage, society, capital punishment would only be confused and darkened by the introduction of Darwinist theories from the third section seems to be grasped by Strauss himself, for he in fact pays no further regard to these theories. But the question 'are we still Christians?' at once prejudices freedom of philosophical reflection and gives it an unpleasant theological colouring; in addition to which he has quite forgotten that even today the greater part of mankind is still Buddhist and not Christian. Why should we without more ado think at the words 'old faith' of Christianity alone! If Strauss herewith reveals that he has never ceased to be a Christian theologian and has thus never learned to become a philosopher, he further surprises us by his inability to distinguish between faith and knowledge and by continually naming his so-called 'new faith' and the contemporary sciences in the same breath. Or should we regard the new faith as only an ironical accommodation to linguistic usage? It almost seems so when we see that here and there he innocently lets new faith and contemporary science deputize for one another, for example on page 11, where he asks on which side, that of the old faith or that of contemporary science, 'there are to be found more of the obscurities and inadequacies unavoidable in human affairs'. According to his introduction, moreover, he intends to present the evidence upon which the modern philosophy of life

depends: all this evidence he borrows from science and here too he adopts wholly the posture of a man of knowledge, not that of a believer. At bottom, then, the new religion is not a new faith but precisely on a par with modern science and thus not religion at all. If Strauss nevertheless asserts that he does have a religion, the reasons for it lie outside the domain of contemporary science. Only a minute portion of Strauss's book, amounting to no more than a few scattered pages, treats of that which Strauss could have a right to call a faith: namely that feeling for the cosmos for which he demands the same piety as 4 1 III II ' the believer of the old stamp feels towards his God. In these pages at least the scientific spirit is certainly not in evidence: but we could wish for a little more strength and naturalness of faith! For what is so extremely striking is the artificiality of the procedures our author has to adopt in order to convince himself he still possesses a faith and a religion at all: as we have seen, he has to resort to jabbing -and cudgelling. It creeps weakly along, this stimulated faith: we freeze at the sight of it. Strauss promises in his introduction to test whether this new faith is capable of doing for the new believer what the old faith does for the believer of the old stamp, but in the end he himself comes to think he has promised too much. For when he deals with the subject he does so in a quite offhand, indeed almost embarrassed manner, in a couple of pages (pp. 366f.), even resorting to the desperate ploy: 'whoever cannot help himself here is beyond help and is not yet ripe for our point of view' (p. 366). Consider with what weight of conviction the Stoic of antiquity believed in the cosmos and in the rationality of the cosmos, and contrast with it even the claim to originality which Strauss makes for his faith! But, as we have said, whether it is new or old, original or imitated, would be a matter of indifference if only it exhibited naturalness, health and strength. Strauss himself leaves this distilled emergency faith in the lurch whenever the claims of knowledge constrain him to do so and in order to present his newly acquired scientific perception to his 'we' with a quieter conscience. The timidity with which he speaks of his faith is matched by his loud orotundity whenever he cites the greatest benefactor of most recent mankind, Darwin: here he demands faith, not merely in the new Messiah, but in himself, the new apostle, too; for example when, dealing with the most intricate theme of natural science, he pronounces with a truly antique pride: 'I shall be told I am speaking of things I do not understand. Good; but others will come who understand them and who have also understood me.' From this it seems almost as though the celebrated 'we' are to be obligated to a faith, not only in the cosmos, but in Strauss the natural scientist too; in that case all we would ask is that the latter faith should not require for its realization such cruel and painful procedures as the former did. Or can it be that in this instance the 'religious reaction' which is the mark of the 'new faith' will be produced in the believer by the jabbing and cudgelling, not of the believer himself, but of the object of the belief? If so, how

we should profit from the religiosity of these 'we'! David Strauss, the confessor and the writer For otherwise it is almost to be feared that modern men will be able to get along without bothering overmuch with the ingredients of Strauss's religious faith, just as they have in fact hitherto got along without the principle of the rationality of the cosmos. Modern natural science and study of history have nothing whatever to do with the Straussian faith in the cosmos, and that the modern philistine does not need it either is shown by the description of his life which Strauss himself gives in the section 'How do we order our life?' He is therefore right to doubt whether the 'carriage' to which his 'valued readers have had to entrust themselves meets every requirement'. It certainly does not meet them: for modern man travels a lot faster if he is not sitting in this Straussian carriage - or more correctly: he was travelling a lot faster long before this Straussian carriage existed. So if it be true that the celebrated 'minority that can not be ignored' of which and in whose name Strauss speaks really 'sets great store by consistency', then they must be just as dissatisfied with Strauss the carriage-builder as we are with Strauss the logician. But let us forget about the logician: perhaps the book really is well formed artistically, and conforms to the laws of beauty even if it does not possess a well-thought-out logical plan. And it is only now, after determining that he has not borne himself as a scientific, orderly minded and systematizing scholar, that we arrive at the question whether Strauss is a good writer. Perhaps he conceived it as his task, not so much to frighten people away from the 'old faith', as to lure them to the new philosophy of life by depicting it in cheerful and lively colours. If he thought of scholars and the educated as his first readers, he must have realized from his own experience that, while they can be laid low with the heavy artillery of scientific proof, they can never by this means be brought to surrender, though they fall prey all the more readily to lightly clad arts of seductions. 'Lightly clad', and that 'intentionally', is however what Strauss himself calls his book; his public panegyrists also find it and describe it as 'lightly clad', as for example this one does in the following terms: 'The discourse moves forward in a pleasing rhythm and handles the art of demonstration with playful ease when it is engaged critically against what is old, as it does no less when it seductively prepares and presents to both undemanding and experienced palates the new things it brings. The arrangement of such manifold and dissimilar material, where everything is to be touched on but nothing pursued at length, is well thought out; the transitions from one subject to another are especially skilful, and even more admirable, perhaps, is the dexterity with which uncomfortable things are pushed aside or buried in silence.' The senses of such panegyrists are, as is apparent here too, alert not so much to what an author can do as to what he wants to do. What Strauss wants to do, however, is betrayed most clearly in his emphatic and not wholly innocent recommendation of a Voltairean gracefulness in the service of which he could

have learned those 'lightly clad' arts of which his panegyrist speaks - supposing, that is, that virtue can be taught and a pedant can ever become a dancer. Who cannot harbour reservations when for example he reads these words of Strauss's on Voltaire (p. 219): 'as a philosopher Voltaire is not original, it is true, but in the main an elaborator of English researches: yet he proves to be altogether a master of his material, which with incomparable dexterity he illuminates from all sides and thereby, without being strictly methodical, satisfies the demands of thoroughness'. All the negative traits are in keeping: no one will maintain that as a philosopher Strauss is original or strictly methodical; the question is whether we will also acknowledge that he is a 'master of his material' or concede to him 'incomparable dexterity'. The confession that the work is 'intentionally lightly clad' allows us to guess that incomparable dexterity was at any rate intended. Not to build a temple or a dwelling, but to set down a summer house surrounded with horticulture - that was our architect's dream. It almost seems, indeed, that even that mysterious feeling for the cosmos was intended mainly as a means of aesthetic effect, like a view of an irrational element, the sea for instance, from within an elegant and rational terrace. The walk through the first section - that is to say, through the theological catacombs with their obscurity and their convoluted and baroque ornamentation - was again only an aesthetic means of emphasizing by contrast the purity, brightness and rationality of the section entitled 'What is our conception of the world?': for immediately after that walk in the gloom and glimpse of distant irrational windings, we enter a hall with a fanlight; it receives us with cheerful sobriety, there are celestial charts and mathematical figures on the walls and it is filled with scientific apparatus and cup boards lined with skeletons, stuffed monkeys and anatomical specimens. But we do not wholly recover our good humour until we pass through this hall and enter the full domestic ease and comfort of the occupants of our summer-house; we discover them with their David Strauss, the confessor and the writer women and children engaged with their newspapers and common place chatter about politics, we listen for a time as they discuss marriage and universal suffrage, capital punishment and workers' strikes, and it seems to us impossible that the rosary of public opinion could be told more quickly. Finally we are also to be convinced of the classical taste of those who dwell here: a brief visit to the library and the music-room discloses, as expected, that the best books lie on the shelves and the most celebrated pieces of music on the music-stands; they even play us something, and if it was supposed to be Haydn's music at least Haydn was not to blame if it sounded like Riehl's music for the home. In the meantime, the master of the house has had occasion to state that he is in entire agreement with Lessing, also with Goethe, though excluding the second part of Faust. Finally the summer-house owner commends himself, and expresses the view that those he disagrees with are beyond help and not yet ripe for his point of view; whereupon

he offers us his carriage, with the polite reservation that he cannot guarantee it will answer to all our requirements; the stones on his carriageways are, moreover, newly scattered and we might be much buffeted about. Our Epicurean garden god then takes his leave of us with the incomparable dexterity he had recognized and commended in Voltaire. Who could now doubt this incomparable dexterity? We recognize the master of his material, the lightly clad horticulturalist is unmasked; and still we hear the voice of the classic author: 'As a writer I refuse to be a philistine, I refuse! I refuse! I want to be Voltaire, the German Voltaire! and best of all the French Lessing too!' We have betrayed a secret: our Master does not always know who he would prefer to be, Voltaire or Lessing, but wants at no price to be a philistine; if possible, he would like to be both, Lessing and Voltaire - that it might be fulfilled which was written: 'he had no character whatever: whenever he wanted a character he always had to assume one'. If we have understood Strauss the confessor correctly, he himself is a true philistine with a narrow, dried-up soul and with sober and scholarly requirements: and yet no one would be angrier at being called a philistine than David Strauss the writer. He would approve if one called him headstrong, rash, malicious, foolhardy; but he would be most pleased of all to be compared with Lessing or Voltaire, since they were certainly not philistines. In his search to procure this pleasure he is often undecided whether he ought to imitate the bold dialectical impetuosity of Lessing or whether it might not be better to comport himself as a satyr-like free-spirited elder in the manner of Voltaire. Whenever he sits down to write he always composes his features as though he were about to have his portrait painted: some times he makes his face resemble Lessing's, sometimes Voltaire's. When we read his praise of the Voltairean style (p. 217), he seems to be expressly admonishing the present for not having long since recognized what it possesses in the modern Voltaire: 'the merits of his style', Strauss says, 'are everywhere the same: simple naturalness, transparent clarity, lively flexibility, pleasing charm. Warmth and emphasis are not wanting where they are needed; hatred of pomposity and affectation came from Voltaire's innermost nature; just as when, on the other hand, passion and impetuosity lowered the tone of his discourse, the fault lay not with the stylist but with the human being in him.' To judge from this, Strauss is well aware of the significance of simplicity of style: it has always been the mark of genius, which also possesses the privilege of expressing itself simply, naturally and with naivety. It therefore betrays no common ambition when an author chooses a simple style: for, although many will see what such an author would like to be taken for, there are nonetheless many who are so obliging as to take him for it. But if an author possesses genius he betrays it in more than simplicity and precision of expression: his abundant power plays with his material even when it is difficult and dangerous. Stiff and timid steps will get no one along unfamiliar

paths littered with a thousand abysses: the genius, however, runs nimbly along such paths with daring or elegant strides and disdains cautiously to measure his steps. That the problems Strauss passes in review are serious and dreadful ones, and have been treated as such by the wise of every age, is known to Strauss himself, and yet he calls his book lightly clad. Of all the dread and gloomy seriousness of reflection into which one is plunged perforce when faced with the questions of the value of existence and the duties of man there is not the slightest suspicion as our gifted Master goes fluttering past us, 'lightly clad and intentionally so' more lightly clad, indeed, than is his Rousseau, who, he informs us, denuded his lower half and draped his upper, while Goethe, he says, draped his lower half and denuded his upper. Wholly naive geniuses, it seems, do not drape themselves at all, so perhaps the expression 'lightly clad' is only a euphemism for naked. David Strauss, the confessor and the writer Of the goddess truth, the few who have seen her affirm that she has been naked: and perhaps in the eyes of those who have not seen her but accept the word of those few who have, nakedness or lightly cladness is in itself a proof of truth, even if only circumstantial proof. Merely to suspect that this is the case works to the advantage of an author's ambition: someone sees something naked - 'suppose it should be the truth!' he says to himself, and assumes a more solemn expression than the one he usually wears. But an author has already attained much if he has constrained his reader to regard him more solemnly than he does some other, more heavily clad author. It is the way to one day becoming a 'classic': and Strauss himself tells us that he has 'been accorded the unsought honour of being regarded as a kind of classic prose-writer', that he has thus arrived at the goal of his journey. Strauss the genius runs about the streets as a 'classic' disguised as a lightly clad goddess, and Strauss the philistine is, to employ an original locution of this genius, at all costs to be 'decreed out of fashion' or 'thrown out never to return'. Alas, the philistine does return, again and again, despite all such decrees and throwings-out! Alas, the face, twisted into a semblance of Voltaire or Lessing, from time to time snaps back into its old, honest, original shape! Alas, the mask of genius all too often falls off, and the Master never wears a more vexed expression, his gestures are never stiffer, than when he has just attempted to imitate the stride of genius and to make his eyes flash with the fire of genius. Ours is a cold climate, and it is precisely because he goes around so lightly clad that he runs the risk of catching cold more often and more gravely than others; that the others then notice all this may be acutely painful, but if he is ever to be cured he will have to submit to the following public diagnosis: There was once a Strauss, a brave, rigorous and austere clad scholar-, whom we found as congenial as anyone who in Germany serves truth seriously and with vigour and knows how to stay within his own limitations; he who is now celebrated by public opinion as David Strauss has become someone else: it may be the fault of

the theologians that he has become this someone else; enough, we find the game he now plays with the mask of genius as repellent or ludicrous as we found his former seriousness evocative of seriousness and sympathy. When he now informs us: 'it would also be an act of ingratitude towards my genius if I did not rejoice that, beside the gift of unsparing destructive criticism, I have also been granted the innocent pleasure of artistic creativity', it may surprise him to know that despite this self-testimonial there are people who maintain the opposite: firstly, that he has never possessed the gift of artistic creativity, and then that the pleasure he calls 'innocent' is anything but innocent, inasmuch as it gradually undermined a fundamentally vigorous and deep-seated scholarly and critical nature - that is to say, the genius Strauss actually did possess - and in the end destroyed it. In an access of unrestrained candour, Strauss himself concedes that he has always 'had his own Merck within him, who cried to him: you must no longer produce such trash, others can do that!' This was the voice of the genuine Straussian genius: and it even tells him how much or how little his latest, innocently lightly clad testament of the modern philistine is worth. Others can do that too! And many could do it better! And those who could do it best, more gifted and richer spirits than Strauss, would, when they had done it, never have produced any thing other than - trash. I believe I have made it clear how I regard Strauss the writer: as an actor who plays at being a genius and classic. Lichtenberg once said: 'The simple style is to be recommended first of all because no honest man subjects what he has to say to artificial elaboration', but that certainly does not mean that the simple manner is a proof of authorial integrity. I could wish that Strauss the writer were more honest, for then he would write better and be less celebrated. Or - if he absolutely must be an actor - I could wish he were a good actor and knew better how to imitate the style of naive genius and the classic. For it remains to be said that Strauss is in fact a bad actor and utterly worthless as a stylist. 1 1 The reproach that one is not a good writer is softened, to be sure, by the fact that in Germany it is very difficult to become even a mediocre and tolerable writer, and quite astonishingly improbable that one will become a good one. A natural basis is lacking, an artistic evaluation, treatment and cultivation of oral speech. As the expressions 'salon conversation', 'sermon', 'parliamentary oratory', indicate, public speech has in Germany not yet attained to a national style or even to the desire for a style; language has not yet emerged from the stage of naive experimentation; so that there is no unified norm by which the writer may be guided and he thus has a certain right to handle language on his own responsibility: and this must result in that limitless dilapidation of the German language which constitutes the 'language of the present' and which has been described most forcefully by Schopenhauer. 'If this goes on', he once said, 'in the year 1900 the German classics will no longer be comprehensible, since the only

language understood will be the shabby jargon of our noble "present" the basic character of which is impotence.' Already, indeed, German linguistic arbiters and grammarians writing in the most recent journals give the impression that our classics can no longer be valid to us as stylistic models because they employ a large number of words, locutions and syntactical figures which we have lost: for which reason it might seem appropriate to collect together the masterpieces of our present literary celebrities for the purpose of imitating their vocabulary and phraseology, as has in fact been done by Sander in his concise pocket dictionary of infamous language. Here the repellent stylistic monster Gutzkow appears as a classic: and it seems that we have in general to accustom ourselves to a whole new and surprising host of 'classics', among whom the first, or one of the first, is David Strauss whom we cannot describe in any way other than we have already described him: as a worthless stylist. Now, it is extremely characteristic of the pseudo-culture of the cultural philistine that he should even appropriate the concept of the classic and the model writer he who exhibits his strength only in warding off a real, artistically vigorous cultural style and through steadfastness in warding off arrives at a homogeneity of expression which almost resembles a unity of style. How is it possible that, given the limitless experimentation with language everyone is permitted to indulge in, certain individual authors nonetheless discover a universally agreeable tone of voice? What is it really that is here so universally agreeable? Above all a negative quality: the absence of anything offensive - but anything truly productive is offensive. - For the greater part of what the German of today reads undoubtedly comprises the newspapers and the magazines that go with them: the language here employed, a ceaseless drip of the same locutions and the same words, imprints itself on his ear, and since he usually reads this literature at times when his wearied mind is in any case little capable of resistance, his ear for language gradually comes to feel at home in this everyday German and is pained when it notices its absence. The manufacturers of these newspapers, however, are, as would be expected from their whole way of life, the most accustomed to the slime of this newspaper language: they have in the strictest sense of the word lost all taste, and the most their tongue can still savour with any kind of pleasure is the totally corrupt and capricious. This explains the tutti unisono which, notwithstanding the general debility and sickness, greets every newly invented solecism: such impudent corruptions are an act of revenge on the language for the unbelievable boredom it inflicts upon its day-labourers. I recall having read an appeal 'to the German people' by Berthold Auerbach in which every locution was an un-German distortion and falsification of the language, and which as a whole resembled a soulless mosaic of words stuck together with an international syntax; not to speak of the shamelessly slovenly German with which Eduard Devrient celebrated the memory of Mendelssohn. Thus the solecism - this is the

remarkable thing- is felt by our philistines, not as objectionable, but as a stimulating refreshment in the arid and treeless desert of everyday German. But the truly productive he does find objectionable. The most modern model author is not merely forgiven his distorted, extravagant or threadbare syntax and his ludicrous neologisms, they are reckoned a merit in him which gives his work piquancy: but woe to the stylist with character who avoids these everyday locutions as seriously and persistently as he does 'tie monsters of present-day scribbling hatched out last night', as Schopenhauer puts it. When platitudes, commonplaces and hackneyed and feeble language are the rule, and badness and corruption received as stimulating exceptions, then the forceful, uncommon and beautiful falls into dis favour: so that in Germany there is constantly being repeated the story of the traveller who came to the land of the hunchbacks and was shamefully insulted by its inhabitants because of his supposedly defective physique, until at last a priest had mercy on him and said to the people: 'Rather pity this poor stranger and sacrifice to the gods in gratitude for having adorned you with this stately hump.' If anyone should compose a grammar of current everyday German and trace the rules which, as an unwritten and unspoken yet compelling imperative, govern everyone's writing-desk, he would encounter some strange notions of style and rhetoric, taken perhaps from recollections of school and enforced Latin exercises, perhaps from reading French writers at whose astonishing crudeness any properly educated Frenchman would have a right to scoff. It seems that, though reputed thorough, the Germans have never yet reflected on these strange notions, under the rule of which more or less every German lives and writes. Then we have the demand that from time to time a simile or a metaphor should appear, and that the metaphor must be a new one: but to the poor writer's brain new and modern are the same thing, David Strauss, the confessor and the writer and it now torments itself to draw metaphors from the railway, the telegraph, the steam-engine, the stock exchange, and feels proud of the fact that these similes must be new because they are modern. In Strauss's confessional book we find ample tribute paid to the modern metaphor: he dismisses us with a page-and-a-half long simile drawn from road improvement works, a few pages earlier he compares the world to a machine with its wheels, pistons, hammers and 'soothing oil'. - A meal which starts with champagne (p. 362). Kant as a hydro pathic establishment (p. 325). 'The Swiss constitution compares with the English as a watermill compares with a steam-engine, a waltz or a song with a fugue or a symphony' (p. 265). 'In the case of every appeal, the correct succession of tribunals must be adhered to. The intermediate tribunal between the individual and mankind, however, is the nation' (p. 258). 'If we wish to discover whether life in fact exists in an organism that seems to us dead, we usually test it by administering a strong, often painful stimulus, a jab for instance' (p. 141). 'The religious domain in the human soul is like the domain of

the Redskin in America' (p. 1 38). 'To set down the sum total of all the preceding in round numbers at the bottom of the bill' (p. 90). 'The Darwinian theory is like a railway track that has just been marked out . . . where the banners flutter gaily in the wind' (p. 1 76). It is in this way, namely the most modern way, that Strauss has complied with the philistine demand that from time to time a new metaphor must make an appearance. Also very widespread is a further demand that didactic statements must be composed in long sentences employing abstractions, while those intended to persuade should preferably be in short little sentences with contrasting forms of expression hopping one after the other. Strauss provides on page 1 32 a model sentence of the didactic and scholarly kind: inflated to truly Schleiermacherish proportions, it creeps along at the pace of a tortoise: 'That at the earlier stages of religion, instead of a single such Whence there appear many, instead of one God there appears a multiplicity of gods, is, according to this derivation of religion, due to the fact that the various natural forces or conditions of life which arouse in man the feeling of absolute dependence still act upon him in the beginning in all their multifariousness, he has not yet become aware how in regard to his absolute dependence upon them there is no distinction between them, consequently the Whence of this dependence or the Being to which in the last instance they are to be traced back can be only one.' An example of the opposite kind of thing, of the short little sentences 5 1 and affected vivacity which have so excited some readers they can now mention Strauss only in concert with Lessing, can be found on page 8: 'I am well aware that what I propose to discuss in the following pages is known just as well by countless other people and by some it is known better. Some of them have already spoken out. Should I therefore keep silent? I do not believe so. For we all supplement one another. If another knows many things better than I, perhaps I know a few things better than he; and I have a viewpoint on many things different from the viewpoint of others. So out with it, let me display my colours, that it may be seen whether or not they are genuine.' To be sure, Strauss's style usually maintains a mean between this free and-easy quick-march and the funereal crawl of the first example: but between two vices there does not always dwell virtue; all too often what dwells there is weakness, lameness and impotence. I was very disappointed, in fact, when I looked through Strauss's book in search of more subtle and wittier traits and expressions; since I had found nothing praiseworthy in the confessor I actually established a heading under which to list such passages, so that I might at least be able to say something in praise of Strauss the writer. I searched and searched but could list nothing. On the other hand, a second list with the heading 'Solecisms, confused similes, obscure abbreviations, tastelessness and affectation' became so full I can venture to reproduce here only a modest selection of the examples assembled. Perhaps it will reveal precisely what it is that evokes in the contemporary German his belief that Strauss is a

great stylist: for here we find curiosities of expression which in the arid dust and desert of the book as a whole offer if not pleasant at any rate painfully stimulating surprises: on encountering such passages we notice, to employ a Straussian metaphor, that at least we are not yet dead by the way we react to these jabs. For the rest of the book displays a total lack of anything whatever offensive, that is to say productive, such as would now be reckoned a positive quality in the classic prose-writer. Extreme sobriety and aridity, a truly starving sobriety, nowadays awakens in the educated masses the unnatural feeling that precisely these are the signs of flourishing health, so that here there apply the words of the author of the *Dialogus de Oratibus*: 'illam ipsam quam iactant sanitatem non firmitate sed ieiunio consequuntur' . * With instinctive unanimity, they hate allfirmitas because it bears witness to a healthi ness quite different from theirs, and seek to throw suspicion on *illam ipsam quam iactant sanitatem non firmitate sed ieiunio consequuntur: even their health, which they parade, they obtain not through strength but through fasting (Tacitus) David Strauss, the confessor and the writer firmitas,. on conciseness, on fiery energy of movement, on abundant and delicate play of the muscles. They have agreed together to invert the nature and names of things and henceforth to speak of health where we see weakness, of sickness and tension where we encounter true health. That is how David Strauss comes to be accounted a 'classic'. If only this sobriety were at least a stricdy logical sobriety: but sim plicity and rigour in thinking is precisely what these weaklings lack, and in their hands language itself becomes a logical tangle. Just try translating this Straussian style into Latin - which can be done even with Kant, and with Schopenhauer is pleasurable and easy. The reason Strauss's German is altogether unamenable to it is probably not that his German is more German than Kant's or Schopenhauers, but that his German is confused and illogical while theirs is informed with grandeur and simplicity. He who knows the effort the ancients expended on learning to speak and write, and how the moderns make no such effort, feels, as Schopenhauer once said, a real sense of relief when, having been compelled to wade through a German book like this one, he turns to those other ancient yet ever new languages: 'for with these', he says, 'I have before me a language with fixed rules and a firmly established and faithfully observed grammar and orthography and can devote myself wholly to the thought expressed in it; while with German I am continually dis tracted by the impudence of the writer seeking to obtrude his own grammatical and orthographical whims and eccentricities: a piece of swaggering folly I find repellent. I t is truly an agony to see a fair and ancient language possessing a classical literature mishandled by ignoramuses and asses.' Thus Schopenhauer's holy wrath cries out to you, so you cannot say you were not warned. But he who absolutely refuses to heed this warning, and insists on continuing in his belief that Strauss is a classic, should, as a final word of advice, be recommended to

imitate him. If you do try this, though, it will be at your peril: you will have to pay for it, in your style and, eventually, in your head, that the dictum of Indian wisdom may be fulfilled in you too: 'To gnaw at the horn of a cow is useless and shortens life: you grind down your teeth and yet you get no nourishment.'¹ 2 In conclusion we shall now place before our classic prose-writer the promised collection of examples of his style; perhaps Schopenhauer would give it the title: 'New documents of the shabby jargon of today'; for, if it is any comfort to him, David Strauss may be comforted to be told that nowadays all the world writes as he does, and some people write even worse than he, and that in the country of the blind the one-eyed man is king. Indeed, we concede to him a great deal when we concede to him one eye; we do so, however, because at least Strauss does not write like the most infamous of all corrupters of German, the Hegelians and their deformed offspring. At least he wants to get back out of this swamp and he has partly succeeded, though he is as yet very far from being on firm land; it is still noticeable that in his youth he stuttered Hegelian: something in him became dislocated at that time, some muscle got stretched; his ear became dulled, like the ear of a boy brought up amid the beating of drums, so that thereafter he became deaf to the subtle and mighty laws of sound under whose rule every writer lives who has been strictly trained to follow good models. He therewith lost as a stylist his best possessions and, if he is not to slip back into the Hegelian mud, is condemned to live out his life on the barren and perilous quicksands of newspaper style. Nonetheless he has succeeded in becoming famous for a couple of hours in our time, and perhaps there will be a couple of hours more when it will be remembered that he was once famous; but then night will come and he will be forgotten: and already at this moment, as we inscribe his stylistic sins in the black book, twilight begins to fall on his fame. For he who has sinned against the German language has profaned the mystery of all that is German: through all the confusion and changes of nations and customs, it alone has, as by a metaphysical magic, preserved itself and therewith the German spirit. It alone also guarantees the future of this spirit, provided it does not itself perish at the hands of the present. 'But *Di meliora!** Away, pachyderms, away! This is the Gennan language, in which men have spoken, in which great poets have sung and great thinkers written. Keep your paws off!' - [Nietzsche now gives some 70 examples of the kind of language in which *Der alte und neue Glaube* is written and subjects them to a scathing commentary. The faults exposed include grammatical errors of various kinds, offences against good usage, jumbled metaphors, impossible imagery and meaninglessness; and the critique substantiates the charge that Strauss has lost all feeling for German and any clear awareness of the meaning of the words he uses. To attempt to translate Strauss's faulty sentences into English equivalents would be an enjoy- "*Di meliora!* : O ye good gods! David Strauss, the confessor and the writer able but otherwise

senseless exercise in ingenuity; and for the reader who cannot read these sentences in the original German Nietzsche's comments must lose most of their relevance and force. The sensible course would therefore seem to be to omit this passage.] Herewith I have completed my confession of faith. It is the confession of an individual; and what can such an individual do against all the world, even if his voice is audible everywhere! His judgment would - to leave you with one last genuine feather from the Straussian plumage - be only 'of as much subjective truth as without any objective power of proof':- is that not so, my dear friends? So continue to be of good cheer! For the time being at least let it rest with your 'of as much . . . as without'. For the time being? That is to say, for as long as that for which it is always time, and which the present time has more need of than ever, continues to count as untimely - I mean: telling the truth. On the Uses and Disadvantages of History for Life Foreword 'In any case, I hate everything that merely instructs me without augmenting or directly invigorating my activity.' These words are from Goethe, and they may stand as a sincere *ceterum censeo** at the beginning of our meditation on the value of history. For its intention is to show why instruction without invigoration, why knowledge not attended by action, why history as a costly superfluity and luxury, must, to use Goethe's word, be seriously hated by us - hated because we still lack even the things we need and the superfluous is the enemy of the necessary. We need history, certainly, but we need it for reasons different from those for which the idler in the garden of knowledge needs it, even though he may look nobly down on our rough and charmless needs and requirements. We need it, that is to say, for the sake of life and action, not so as to turn comfortably away from life and action, let alone for the purpose of extenuating the self seeking life and the base and cowardly action. We want to serve history only to the extent that history serves life: for it is possible to value the study of history to such a degree that life becomes stunted and degenerate - a phenomenon we are now forced to acknowledge, painful though this may be, in the face of certain striking symptoms of our age. I have striven to depict a feeling by which I am constantly tormented; I revenge myself upon it by handing it over to the public. Perhaps this depiction will inspire someone or other to tell me that he too knows this feeling but that I have not felt it in its pure and elemental state and have certainly not expressed it with the assurance that comes from mature experience. Someone, I say, may perhaps do so: most people, however, will tell me that this feeling is altogether perverse, unnatural, detestable and wholly impermissible, and that by feeling it I have shown myself unworthy of the mighty historical movement which, as is well known, has been in evidence among the Germans particularly for the past two generations. Whatever the case, however, that I should venture a description of my feeling will promote rather than injure general decorum, *ceterum censeo*: but I'm of the opinion 'I since it will offer to

many the opportunity of paying compliments to the said movement. And for myself I shall gain something that is worth more to me even than decorum - that is, to be publicly instructed and put right about the character of our own time. This meditation too is untimely, because I am here attempting to look afresh at something of which our time is rightly proud - its cultivation of history as being injurious to it, a defect and deficiency in it; because I believe, indeed, that we are all suffering from a consuming fever of history and ought at least to recognize that we are suffering from it. But if Goethe was right to assert that when we cultivate our virtues we at the same time cultivate our faults, and if, as everyone knows, a hypertrophied virtue such as the historical sense of our age appears to be - can ruin a nation just as effectively as a hypertrophied vice: then there can be no harm in indulging me for this once. And it may partly exonerate me when I give an assurance that the experiences which evoked those tormenting feelings were mostly my own and that I have drawn on the experiences of others only for purposes of comparison; and further, that it is only to the extent that I am a pupil of earlier times, especially the Hellenic, that though a child of the present time I was able to acquire such untimely experiences. That much, however, I must concede to myself on account of my profession as a classicist: for I do not know what meaning classical studies could have for our time if they were not untimely - that is to say, acting counter to our time and thereby acting on our time and, let us hope, for the benefit of a time to come. Consider the cattle, grazing as they pass you by: they do not know what is meant by yesterday or today, they leap about, eat, rest, digest, leap about again, and so from morn till night and from day to day, fettered to the moment and its pleasure or displeasure, and thus neither melancholy nor bored. This is a hard sight for man to see; for, though he thinks himself better than the animals because he is human, he cannot help envying them their happiness - what they have, a life neither bored nor painful, is precisely what he wants, yet he cannot have it because he refuses to be like an animal. A human being may well ask an animal: 'Why do you not speak to me of your happiness but only stand and gaze at me?' The animal would like to answer, and say: 'The reason is I always forget what I was going to say on the uses and disadvantages of history for life' - but then he forgot this answer too, and stayed silent: so that the human being was left wondering. But he also wonders at himself, that he cannot learn to forget but clings relentlessly to the past: however far and fast he may run, this chain runs with him. And it is a matter for wonder: a moment, now here and then gone, nothing before it came, again nothing after it has gone, nonetheless returns as a ghost and disturbs the peace of a later moment. A leaf flutters from the scroll of time, floats away - and suddenly floats back again and falls into the man's lap. Then the man says 'I remember' and envies the animal, who at once forgets and for whom every moment really dies, sinks back into night and fog and is extinguished for ever. Thus the animal lives

unhistorically: for it is contained in the present, like a number without any awkward fraction left over; it does not know how to dissimulate, it conceals nothing and at every instant appears wholly as what it is; it can therefore never be anything but honest. Man, on the other hand, braces himself against the great and ever greater pressure of what is past: it pushes him down or bends him sideways, it encumbers his steps as a, dark, invisible burden which he can sometimes appear to disown and which in traffic with his fellow men he is only too glad to disown, so as to excite their envy. That is why it affects him like a vision of a lost paradise to see the herds grazing or, in closer proximity to him, a child which, having as yet nothing of the past to shake off, plays in blissful blindness between the hedges of past and future. Yet its play must be disturbed; all too soon it will be called out of its state of forgetfulness. Then it will learn to understand the phrase 'it was': that password which gives conflict, suffering and satiety access to man so as to remind him what his existence fundamentally is - an imperfect tense that can never become a perfect one. If death at last brings the desired forgetting, by that act it at the same time extinguishes the present and all existence and therewith sets the seal on the knowledge that existence is only an uninterrupted has-been, a thing that lives by negating, consuming and contradicting itself. If happiness, if reaching out for new happiness, is in any sense what fetters living creatures to life and makes them go on living, then perhaps no philosopher is more justified than the Cynic: for the happiness of the animal, as the perfect Cynic, is the living proof of the rightness of Cynicism. The smallest happiness, if only it is present uninterruptedly and makes happy, is incomparably more happiness than the greatest happiness that comes only as an episode, as it were a piece of waywardness or folly, in a continuum of joylessness, desire and privation. In the case of the smallest or of the greatest happiness, however, it is always the same thing that makes happiness happiness: the ability to forget or, expressed in more scholarly fashion, the capacity to feel unhistorically during its duration. He who cannot sink down on the threshold of the moment and forget all the past, who cannot stand balanced like a goddess of victory without growing dizzy and afraid, will never know what happiness is worse, he will never do anything to make others happy. Imagine the extremest possible example of a man who did not possess the power of forgetting at all and who was thus condemned to see everywhere a state of becoming: such a man would no longer believe in his own being, would no longer believe in himself, would see everything flowing asunder in moving points and would lose himself in this stream of becoming: like a true pupil of Heraclitus, he would in the end hardly dare to raise his finger. Forgetting is essential to action of any kind, just as not only light but darkness too is essential for the life of everything organic. A man who wanted to feel historically through and through would be like one forcibly deprived of sleep, or an animal that had to live only by rumination and

ever repeated rumination. Thus: it is possible to live almost without memory, and to live happily moreover, as the animal demonstrates; but it is altogether impossible to live at all without forgetting. Or, to express my theme even more simply: there is a degree of sleeplessness, of rumination, of the historical sense, which is harmful and ultimately fatal to the living thing — whether this living thing be a man or a people or a culture. To determine this degree, and therewith the boundary at which the past has to be forgotten if it is not to become the gravedigger of the present, one would have to know exactly how great the plastic power of a man, a people, a culture is: I mean by plastic power the capacity to develop out of oneself in one's own way, to transform and incorporate into oneself what is past and foreign, to heal wounds, to replace what has been lost, to recreate broken moulds. There are people who possess so little of this power that they can perish from a single experience, from a single painful event, often and especially from a single subtle piece of injustice, like a man bleeding to death from a scratch; on the other hand, there are those who are so little affected by the worst and most dreadful disasters, and even by their own wicked acts, that they are able to feel tolerably well and be in possession of a kind of clear conscience even in the midst of them or at any rate very soon afterwards. The stronger the innermost roots of a man's nature, the more readily will he be able to assimilate and on the uses and disadvantages of history for life appropriate the things of the past; and the most powerful and tremendous nature would be characterized by the fact that it would know no boundary at all at which the historical sense began to overwhelm it; it would draw to itself and incorporate into itself all the past, its own and that most foreign to it, and as it were transform it into blood. That which such a nature cannot subdue it knows how to forget; it no longer exists, the horizon is rounded and closed, and there is nothing left to suggest there are people, passions, teachings, goals lying beyond it. And this is a universal law: a living thing can be healthy, strong and fruitful only when bounded by a horizon; if it is incapable of drawing a horizon around itself, and at the same time too self-centred to enclose its own view within that of another, it will pine away slowly or hasten to its timely end. Cheerfulness, the good conscience, the joyful deed, confidence in the future — all of them depend, in the case of the individual as of a nation, on the existence of a line dividing the bright and discernible from the unilluminable and dark; on one's being just as able to forget at the right time as to remember at the right time; on the possession of a powerful instinct for sensing when it is necessary to feel historically and when unhistorically. This, precisely, is the proposition the reader is invited to meditate upon: the unhistorical and the historical are necessary in equal measure for the health of an individual, of a people and of a culture. First of all, there is an observation that everyone must have made: a man's historical sense and knowledge can be very limited, his horizon as narrow as that of a dweller in the Alps, all his judgments may involve

injustice and he may falsely suppose that all his experiences are original to him - yet in spite of this injustice and error he will nonetheless stand there in superlative health and vigour, a joy to all who see him; while close beside him a man far more just and instructed than he sickens and collapses because the lines of his horizon are always restlessly changing, because he can no longer extricate himself from the delicate net of his judiciousness and truth for a simple act of will and desire. On the other hand we have observed the animal, which is quite unhistorical, and dwells within a horizon reduced almost to a point, and yet lives in a certain degree of happiness, or at least without boredom and dissimulation; we shall thus have to account the capacity to feel to a certain degree unhistorically as being more vital and more fundamental, inasmuch as it constitutes the foundation upon which alone anything sound, healthy and great, anything truly human, can grow. The unhistorical is like an atmosphere within which alone life can germinate and with the destruction of which it must vanish. It is true that only by imposing limits on this unhistorical element by thinking, reflecting, comparing, distinguishing, drawing conclusions, only through the appearance within that encompassing cloud of a vivid flash of light thus only through the power of employing the past for the purposes of life and of again introducing into history that which has been done and is gone - did man become man: but with an excess of history man again ceases to exist, and without that envelope of the unhistorical he would never have begun or dared to begin. What deed would man be capable of if he had not first entered into that vaporous region of the unhistorical? Or, to desert this imagery and illustrate by example: imagine a man seized by a vehement passion, for a woman or for a great idea: how different the world has become to him! Looking behind him he seems to himself as though blind, listening around him he hears only a dull, meaningless noise; whatever he does perceive, however, he perceives as he has never perceived before - all is so palpable, close, highly coloured, resounding, as though he apprehended it with all his senses at once. All his valuations are altered and disvalued; there are so many things he is no longer capable of evaluating at all because he can hardly feel them any more: he asks himself why he was for so long the fool of the phrases and opinions of others; he is amazed that his memory revolves unwearyingly in a circle and yet is too weak and weary to take even a single leap out of this circle. It is the condition in which one is the least capable of being just; narrow-minded, ungrateful to the past, blind to dangers, deaf to warnings, one is a little vortex of life in a dead sea of darkness and oblivion: and yet this condition unhistorical, anti-historical through and through is the womb not only of the unjust but of every just deed too; and no painter will paint his picture, no general achieve his victory, no people attain its freedom without having first desired and striven for it in an unhistorical condition such as that described. As he who acts is, in Goethe's words, always

without a conscience, so is he also always without knowledge; he forgets most things so as to do one thing, he is unjust towards what lies behind him, and he recognizes the rights only of that which is now to come into being and no other rights whatever. Thus he who acts loves his deed infinitely more than it deserves to be loved: and the finest deeds take place in such a superabundance of love that, even if their worth were incalculable in other respects, they must still be unworthy of this love. If, in a sufficient number of cases, one could scent out and retro- On the uses and disadvantages of history for life spectively breathe this unhistorical atmosphere within which every great historical event has taken place, he might, as a percipient being, raise himself to a suprahistorical vantage point such as Niebuhr once described as the possible outcome of historical reflection. 'His story, grasped clearly and in detail', he says, 'is useful in one way at least: it enables us to recognize how unaware even the greatest and highest spirits of our human race have been of the chance nature of the form assumed by the eyes through which they see and through which they compel everyone to see - compel, that is, because the intensity of their consciousness is exceptionally great. He who has not grasped this quite definitely and in many instances will be subjugated by the appearance of a powerful spirit who brings to a given form the most impassioned commitment.' We may use the word 'suprahistorical' because the viewer from this vantage point could no longer feel any temptation to go on living or to take part in his story; he would have recognized the essential condition of all happenings - this blindness and injustice in the soul of him who acts; he would, indeed, be cured for ever of taking history too seriously, for he would have learned from all men and all experiences, whether among Greeks or Turks, from a single hour of the first or of the nineteenth century, to answer his own question as to how or to what end life is lived. If you ask your acquaintances if they would like to relive the past ten or twenty years, you will easily discover which- of them is prepared for this suprahistorical standpoint: they will all answer No, to be sure, but they will have different reasons for answering No. Some may perhaps be consoling themselves: 'but the next twenty will be better'; they are those of whom David Hume says mockingly: And from the dregs of life hope to receive What the first sprightly running could not give. Let us call them historical men; looking to the past impels them towards the future and fires their courage to go on living and their hope that what they want will still happen, that happiness lies behind the hill they are advancing towards. These historical men believe that the meaning of existence will come more and more to light in the course of its process, and they glance behind them only so that, from the process so far, they can learn to understand the present and to desire the future more vehemently; they have no idea that, despite their preoccupation with history, they in fact think and act unhistorically, or that their occupation with history stands in the service, not of pure knowledge, but of life. But our question can also be

answered differently.' Again with a No - but with a No for a different reason: with the No of the supra historical man, who sees no salvation in the process and for whom, rather, the world is complete and reaches its finality at each and every moment. What could ten more years teach that the past ten were unable to teach! Whether the sense of this teaching is happiness or resignation or virtue or atonement, suprahistorical men have never been able to agree; but, in opposition to all historical modes of regarding the past, they are unanimous in the proposition: the past and the present are one, that is to say, with all their diversity identical in all that is typical and, as the omnipresence of imperishable types, a motionless structure of a value that cannot alter and a significance that is always the same. Just as the hundreds of different languages correspond to the same typically unchanging needs of man, so that he who understood these needs would be unable to learn anything new from any of these languages, so the suprahistorical thinker beholds the history of nations and of individual life from within, clairvoyantly divining the original meaning of the various hieroglyphics and gradually even coming wearily to avoid the endless stream of new signs: for how should the unending superfluity of events not reduce him to satiety, oversatiety and finally to nausea! So that perhaps the boldest of them is at last ready to say to his heart, with Giacomo Leopardi: Nothing lives that is worthy Thy agitation, and the earth deserves not a sigh. Our being is pain and boredom and the world is din - nothing more. Be calm. But let us leave the suprahistorical men to their nausea and their wisdom: today let us rejoice for once in our unwisdom and, as believers in deeds and progress and as honourers of the process, give ourselves a holiday. Our valuation of the historical may be only an occidental prejudice: but let us at least make progress within this prejudice and not stand still! Let us at least learn better how to employ history for the purpose of life! Then we will gladly acknowledge that the suprahistorical outlook possesses more wisdom than we do, provided we can only be sure that we possess more life: for then our unwisdom will at any rate have more future than their wisdom will. And in order to leave no doubt as to the meaning of this antithesis of life and wisdom, I shall employ an ancient, tried-and tested procedure and straightway propound a number of theses. On the uses and disadvantages of history for life A historical phenomenon, known clearly and completely and resolved into a phenomenon of knowledge, is, for him who has perceived it, dead: for he has recognized in it the delusion, the injustice, the blind passion, and in general the whole earthly and darkening horizon of this phenomenon, and has thereby also understood its power in history. This power has now lost its hold over him insofar as he is a man of knowledge: but perhaps it has not done so insofar as he is a man involved in life. History become pure, sovereign science would be for mankind a sort of conclusion of life and a settling of accounts with it. The study of history is something salutary and fruitful for the future only as

the attendant of a mighty new current of life, of an evolving culture for example, that is to say only when it is dominated and directed by a higher force and does not itself dominate and direct. Insofar as it stands in the service of life, history stands in the service of an un historical power, and, thus subordinate, it can and should never become a pure science such as, for instance; mathematics is. The question of the degree to which life requires the service of history at all, however, is one of the supreme questions and concerns in regard to the health of a man, a people or a culture. For when it attains a certain degree of excess, life crumbles and degenerates, and through this degeneration history itself finally degenerates too. That life is in need of the services of history, however, must be grasped as firmly as must the proposition, which is to be demonstrated later, that an excess of history is harmful to the living man. History pertains to the living man in three respects: it pertains to him as a being who acts and strives, as a being who preserves and reveres, as a being who suffers and seeks deliverance. This threefold relationship corresponds to three species of history - insofar as it is permissible to distinguish between a monumental, an antiquarian and a critical species of history. History belongs above all to the man of deeds and power, to him who fights a great fight, 'who needs models, teachers, comforters and cannot find them among his contemporaries. It belonged thus to Schiller: for our time is so bad, Goethe said, that the poet no longer encounters in the human life that surrounds him a nature he can employ. It is the man of deeds Polybius has in mind when he calls political history the proper preparation for governing a state and the greatest teacher who, by recalling to us the misfortunes of others, instructs us in how we may steadfastly endure our own changes of fortune. He who has learned to recognize in this the meaning of history is vexed at the sight of inquisitive tourists or pedantic micrologists clambering about on the pyramids of the great eras of the past; where he finds inspiration to imitate or to do better, he does not wish to encounter the idler who, hungry for distraction or excitement, prowls around as though among pictures in a gallery. Among these feeble and hopeless idlers, among those around him who seem active but are in fact merely agitated and bustling, the man of action avoids despair and disgust by turning his gaze backwards and pausing for breath in his march towards the goal. His goal, however, is happiness, perhaps not his own but often that of a nation or of mankind as a whole; he flees from resignation and needs history as a specific against it. Mostly there is no reward beckoning him on, unless it be fame, that is, the expectation of a place of honour in the temple of history, where he in turn can be a teacher, comforter and admonisher to those who come after him. For the commandment which rules over him is: that which in the past was able to expand the concept 'man' and make it more beautiful must exist everlastingly, so as to be able to accomplish this everlastingly. That the great moments in the struggle of the human individual constitute a chain, that this chain unites mankind across the

millennia like a range of human mountain peaks, that the summit of such a long-ago moment shall be for me still living, bright and great - that is the fundamental idea of the faith in humanity which finds expression in the demand for a monumental history. But it is precisely this demand that greatness shall be everlasting that sparks off the most fearful of struggles. For everything else that lives jries No. The monumental shall not come into existence - that is the counter-word. Apathetic habit, all that is base and petty, filling every corner of the earth and billowing up around all that is great like a heavy breath of the earth, casts itself across the path that greatness has to tread on its way to immortality and retards, deceives, suffocates and stifles it. This path, however, leads through human brains! Through the brains of timorous and shortlived animals which emerge again and again to the same needs and distresses and fend off destruction only with effort and then only for a short time. For they want first of all but one thing: to live, at any cost. Who would associate them with that hard relay-race of monumental history through which alone greatness goes on living! And yet again and again there awaken some who, On the uses and disadvantages of history for life gaining strength through reflecting on past greatness, are inspired with the feeling that the life of man is a glorious thing, and even that the fairest fruit of this bitter plant is the knowledge that in earlier times someone passed through this existence infused with pride and strength, someone else sunk in profound thoughtfulness, a third exhibiting mercy and helpfulness - all of them, however, leaving behind them a single teaching: that he lives best who has no respect for existence. If the common man takes this little span of time with such gloomy earnestness and clings to it so desperately, those few we have just spoken of have known, on their way to immortality and to monumental history, how to regard it with Olympian laughter or at least with sublime mockery; often they descended to their grave with an ironic smile - for what was there left of them to bury! Only the dross, refuse, vanity, animality that had always weighed them down and that was now consigned to oblivion after having for long been the object of their contempt. But one thing will live, the monogram of their most essential being, a work, an act, a piece of rare enlighten ment, a creation: it will live because posterity cannot do without it. In this transfigured form, fame is something more than the tastiest morsel of our egoism, as Schopenhauer called it: it is the belief in the solidarity and continuity of the greatness of all ages and a protest against the passing away of generations and the transitoriness of things. Of what use, then, is the monumentalistic conception of the past,. engagement with the classic and rare of earlier times, to the man of the present? He learns from it that the greatness that once existed was in any event once possible and may thus be possible again; he goes his way with more cheerful step, for the doubt which assailed him in weaker moments, whether he was not perhaps desiring the impossible, has now been banished. Supposing someone believed that it would

require no more than a hundred men educated and actively working in a new spirit to do away with the bogus form of culture which has just now become the fashion in Germany, how greatly it would strengthen him to realize that the culture of the Renaissance was raised on the shoulders of just such a band of a hundred men. And yet - to learn something new straightaway from this example how inexact, fluid and provisional that comparison would be! How much of the past would have to be overlooked if it was to produce that mighty effect, how violently what is individual in it would have to be forced into a universal mould and all its sharp corners and hard outlines broken up in the interest of conformity! At bottom, indeed, that which was once possible could present itself as a possibility for a second time only if the Pythagoreans were right in believing that when the constellation of the heavenly bodies is repeated the same things, down to the smallest event, must also be repeated on earth: so that whenever the stars stand in a certain relation to one another a Stoic again joins with an Epicurean to murder Caesar, and when they stand in another relation Columbus will again discover America. Only if, when the fifth act of the earth's drama ended, the whole play every time began again from the beginning, if it was certain that the same complex of motives, the same *deus ex machina*, the same catastrophe were repeated at definite intervals, could the man of power venture to desire monumental history in full icon-like veracity, that is to say with every individual peculiarity depicted in precise detail: but that will no doubt happen only when the astronomers have again become astrologers. Until that time, monumental history will have no use for that absolute veracity: it will always have to deal in approximations and generalities, in making what is dissimilar look similar; it will always move to diminish the differences of motives and instigations so as to exhibit the effect monumentally, that is to say as something exemplary and worthy of imitation, at the expense of the causes: so that, since - it as far as possible ignores causes, one might with only slight exaggeration call it a collection of 'effects in themselves', of events which will produce an effect upon all future ages. That which is celebrated at popular festivals, at religious or military anniversaries, is really such an 'effect in itself': it is this which will not let the ambitious sleep, which the brave wear over their heads like an amulet, but it is not the truly historical connexion of cause and effect - which, fully understood, would only demonstrate that the dice-game of chance and the future could never again produce anything exactly similar to what it produced in the past. As long as the soul of historiography lies in the great stimuli that a man of power derives from it, as long as the past has to be described as worthy of imitation, as imitable and possible for a second time, it of course incurs the danger of becoming somewhat distorted, beautified and coming close to free poetic invention; there have been ages, indeed, which were quite incapable of distinguishing between a monumentalized past and a mythical

fiction, because precisely the same stimuli can be derived from the one world as from the other. If, therefore, the monumental mode of regarding history rules over the other modes - I mean over the antiquarian and critical. On the uses and disadvantages of history for life - the past itself suffers harm: whole segments of it are forgotten, despised, and flow away in an uninterrupted colourless flood, and only individual embellished facts rise out of it like islands: the few personalities who are visible at all have something strange and unnatural about them, like the golden hip which the pupils of Pythagoras supposed they saw on their master. Monumental history deceives by analogies: with seductive similarities it inspires the courageous to foolhardiness and the inspired to fanaticism; and when we go on to think of this kind of history in the hands and heads of gifted egoists and visionary scoundrels, then we see empires destroyed, princes murdered, wars and revolutions launched and the number of historical 'effects in themselves', that is to say, effects without sufficient cause, again augmented. So much as a reminder of the harm that monumental history can do among men of power and achievement, whether they be good men or evil: what, however, is it likely to do when the impotent and indolent take possession of it and employ it! Let us take the simplest and most frequent example. Imagine the inartistic natures, and those only weakly endowed, armoured and armed by a monumentalist history of the artists: against whom will they now turn their weapons? Against their arch-enemies, the strong artistic spirits, that is to say against those who alone are capable of learning from that history in a true, that is to say life-enhancing sense, and of transforming what they have learned into a more elevated practice. Their path will be barred, their air darkened, if a half understood monument to some great era of the past is erected as an idol and zealously danced around, as though to say: 'Behold, this is true art: pay no heed to those who are evolving and want something new!' This dancing mob appears to possess even the privilege of determining what is 'good taste': for the creative man has always been at a disadvantage compared with those who have only looked on and taken no part themselves; just as the public house politician has at all times been cleverer, more judicious and more prudent than the statesman who actually rules. But if one goes so far as to employ the popular referendum and the numerical majority in the domain of art, and as it were compels the artist to defend himself before the forum of the aesthetically inactive, then you can take your oath on it in advance that he will be condemned: not in spite of the fact that his judges have solemnly proclaimed the canon of monumental art (that is to say, the art which, according to the given definition, has at all times 'produced an effect'), but precisely because they have: while any art which, because contemporary, is not yet monumental, seems to them unnecessary, unattractive and lacking in the authority conferred by history. On the other hand, their instincts tell them that art can be slain by art: the monumental is never to be

repeated, and to make sure it is not they invoke the authority which the monumental derives from the past. They are connoisseurs of art because they would like to do away with art altogether; they pose as physicians, while their basic intent is to mix poisons; they develop their taste and tongue as they do so as to employ this spoiled taste as an explanation of why they so resolutely reject all the nourishing artistic food that is offered them. For they do not desire to see new greatness emerge: their means of preventing it is to say 'Behold, greatness already exists!' In reality, they are as little concerned about this greatness that already exists as they are about that which is emerging: their lives are evidence of this. Monumental history is the masquerade costume in which their hatred of the great and powerful of their own age is disguised as satiated admiration for the great and powerful of past ages, and muffled in which they invert the real meaning of that mode of regarding history into its opposite; whether they are aware of it or not, they act as though their motto were: let the dead bury the living. Each of the three species of history which exist belongs to a certain soil and a certain climate and only to that: in any other it grows into a devastating weed. If the man who wants to do something great has need of the past at all, he appropriates it by means of monumental history; "he, on the other hand, who likes to persist in the familiar and " the revered of old, tends the past as an antiquarian historian; and only he who is oppressed by a present need, and who wants to throw off this burden at any cost, has need of critical history, that is to say a history that judges and condemns. Much mischief is caused through the thoughtless transplantation of these plants: the critic without need, the antiquary without piety, the man who recognizes greatness but cannot himself do great things, are such plants, estranged from their mother soil and degenerated into weeds. History thus belongs in the second place to him who preserves and reveres - to him who looks back to whence he has come, to where he came into being, with love and loyalty; with this piety he as it were gives thanks for his existence. By tending with care that which has on the uses and disadvantages of history for life existed from of old, he wants to preserve for those who shall come into existence after him the conditions under which he himself came into existence - and thus he serves life. The possession of ancestral goods changes its meaning in such a soul: they rather possess it. The trivial, circumscribed, decaying and obsolete acquire their own dignity and inviolability through the fact that the preserving and revering soul of the antiquarian man has emigrated into them and there made its home. The history of his city becomes for him the history of himself; he reads its walls, its towered gate, its rules and regulations, its holidays, like an illuminated diary of his youth and in all this he finds again himself, his force, his industry, his joy, his judgment, his folly and vices. Here we lived, he says to himself, for here we are living; and here we shall live, for we are tough and not to be ruined overnight. Thus with the aid of this 'we' he looks

beyond his own individual transitory existence and feels himself to be the spirit of his house, his race, his city. Sometimes he even greets the soul of his nation across the long dark centuries of confusion as his own soul; an ability to feel his way back and sense how things were, to detect traces almost extinguished, to read the past quickly and correctly no matter how intricate its palimpsest may be these are his talents and virtues. Endowed with these talents and virtues Goethe stood before Erwin von Steinbach's monumental work; in the storm of his feelings the historical clouds which veiled the time between them were rent apart: it was his recognition, at first sight, of the German work of art 'exerting its power through a strong, rough German soul'. It was the same tendency which directed the Italians of the Renaissance and reawoke in their poets the genius of ancient Italy to a 'wonderful new resounding of the primeval strings', as Jakob Burckhardt puts it. But this antiquarian sense of veneration of the past is of the greatest value when it spreads a simple feeling of pleasure and contentment over the modest; rude, even wretched conditions in which a man or a nation lives; Niebuhr, for example, admits with honourable candour that on moor and heathland, among free peasants who possess a history, he can live contented and never feel the want of art. How could history serve life better than when it makes the less favoured generations and peoples contented with their own homeland and its customs, and restrains them from roving abroad in search of something they think more worth having and engaging in battles for it? Sometimes this clinging to one's own environment and companions, one's own toilsome customs, one's own bare mountainside, looks like obstinacy and ignorance - yet it is a very salutary ignorance and one most calculated to further the interests of the community: a fact of which anyone must be aware who knows the dreadful consequences of the desire for expeditions and adventures, especially when it seizes whole hordes of nations, and who has seen from close up the condition a nation gets into when it has ceased to be faithful to its own origins and is given over to a restless, cosmopolitan hunting after new and ever newer things. The feeling antithetical to this, the contentment of the tree in its roots, the happiness of knowing that one is not wholly accidental and arbitrary but grown out of a past as its heir, flower and fruit, and that one's existence is thus excused and, indeed, justified - it is this which is today usually designated as the real sense of history. This notwithstanding, such a condition is certainly not one in which a man would be most capable of resolving the past into pure knowledge; so that here too, as in the case of monumental history, we perceive that, as long as the study of history serves life and is directed by the vital drives, the past itself suffers. To employ a somewhat free metaphor: the tree is aware of its roots to a greater degree than it is able to see them; but this awareness judges how big they are from the size and strength of its visible branches. If, however, the tree is in error as to this, how greatly it will be in error regarding all the rest of the forest

around it! - for it knows of the forest only that in it which obstructs or favours it and nothing beside. The antiquarian sense of a man, a community, a whole people, always possesses an extremely restricted field of vision; most of what exists it does not perceive at all, and the little it does see it sees much too close up and isolated; it cannot relate what it sees to anything else and it therefore accords everything it sees equal importance and therefore to each individual thing too 'great importance. There is a lack of that discrimination of value and that sense of proportion which would distinguish between the things of the past in a way that would do true justice to them; their measure and proportion is always that accorded them by the backward glance of the antiquarian nation or individual. This always produces one very imminent danger: everything old and past that enters one's field of vision at all is in the end blandly taken to be equally worthy of reverence, while everything that does not approach this antiquity with reverence, that is to say everything new and evolving, is rejected and persecuted. Thus even the Greeks tolerated the hieratic style in their plastic arts beside the free and great; later, indeed, they did not merely tolerate the elevated nose on the uses and disadvantages of history for life and the frosty smile but even made a cult of it. When the senses of a people harden in this fashion, when the study of history serves the life of the past in such a way that it undermines continuing and especially higher life, when the historical sense no longer conserves life but mummifies it, then the tree gradually dies unnaturally from the top downwards to the roots - and in the end the roots themselves usually perish too. Antiquarian history itself degenerates from the moment it is no longer animated and inspired by the fresh life of the present. Its piety withers away, the habit of scholarliness continues without it and rotates in egoistic self-satisfaction around its own axis. Then there appears the repulsive spectacle of a blind rage for collecting, a restless raking together of everything that has ever existed. Man is encased in the stench of must and mould; through the antiquarian approach he succeeds in reducing even a more creative disposition, a nobler desire, to an insatiable thirst for novelty, or rather for an antiquity and for all and everything; often he sinks so low that in the end he is content to gobble down any food whatever, even the dust of bibliographical minutiae. But even when this degeneration does not take place, when antiquarian history does not lose the foundation in which alone it must be rooted if it is to benefit life, sufficient dangers remain should it grow too mighty and overpower the other modes of regarding the past. For it knows only how to preserve life, not how to engender it; it always undervalues that which is becoming because it has no instinct for divining it as monumental history, for example, has. Thus it hinders any firm resolve to attempt something new, thus it paralyses the man of action who, as one who acts, will and must offend some piety or other. The fact that something has grown old now gives rise to the demand that it be made immortal; for when one considers all that such an

antiquity - an ancient custom of the ancestors, a religious belief, an inherited political privilege - has experienced during the course of its existence, how great a sum of piety and reverence on the part of individuals and generations, then it must seem arrogant or even wicked to replace such an antiquity with a novelty and to set against such a numerical accumulation of acts of piety and reverence the single unit of that which is evolving and has just arrived. Here it becomes clear how necessary it is to mankind to have, beside the monumental and antiquarian modes of regarding the past, a third mode, the critical: and this, too, in the service of life. If he is to live, man must possess and from time to time employ the strength to break up and dissolve a part of the past: he does this by bringing it before the tribunal, scrupulously examining it and finally condemning it; every past, however, is worthy to be condemned for that is the nature of human things: human violence and weakness have always played a mighty role in them. It is not justice which here sits in judgment; it is even less mercy which pronounces the verdict: it is life alone, that dark, driving power that insatiably thirsts for itself. Its sentence is always unmerciful, always unjust, because it has never proceeded out of a pure well of knowledge; but in most cases the sentence would be the same even if it were pronounced by justice itself. 'For all that exists is worthy of perishing. So it would be better if nothing existed.' It requires a great deal of strength to be able to live and to forget the extent to which to live and to be unjust is one and the same thing. Luther himself once opined that the world existed only through a piece of forgetful negligence on God's part: for if God had foreseen 'heavy artillery' he would not have created the world. Sometimes, however, this same life that requires forgetting demands a temporary suspension of this forgetfulness; it wants to be clear as to how unjust the existence of any thing - a privilege, a caste, a dynasty, for example - is, and how greatly this thing deserves to perish. Then its past is regarded critically, then one takes the knife to its roots; then one cruelly tramples over every kind of piety. It is always a dangerous process, especially so for life itself: and men and ages which serve life by judging and destroying a past are always dangerous and endangered men and ages. For since we are the outcome of earlier generations, we are also the outcome of their aberrations, passions and errors, and indeed of their crimes; it is not possible wholly to free oneself from this chain. If we condemn these aberrations and regard ourselves as free of them, this does not alter the fact that we originate in them. The best we can do is to confront our inherited and hereditary nature with our knowledge, and through a new, stern discipline combat our inborn heritage and implant in ourselves a new habit, a new instinct, a second nature, so that our first nature withers away. It is an attempt to give oneself, as it were a posteriori, a past in which one would like to originate in opposition to that in which one did originate: - always a dangerous attempt because it is so hard to know the limit to denial of the past and because second

natures are usually weaker than first. What happens all too often is that we know the good but do not do it, because we also know the better but cannot do it. But here and there a victory is nonetheless achieved, and for the combatants, for those who on the uses and disadvantages of history for life employ critical history for the sake of life, there is even a noteworthy consolation: that of knowing that this first nature was once a second nature and that every victorious second nature will become a first. These are the services history is capable of performing for life; every man and every nation requires, in accordance with its goals, energies and needs, a certain kind of knowledge of the past, now in the form of monumental, now of antiquarian, now of critical history: but it does not require it as a host of pure thinkers who only look on at life, of knowledge-thirsty individuals whom knowledge alone will satisfy and to whom the accumulation of knowledge is itself the goal, but always and only for the ends of life and thus also under the dominion and supreme direction of these ends. That this is the natural relationship of an age, a culture, a nation with its history - evoked by hunger, regulated by the extent of its need, held in bounds by its inherent plastic powers - that knowledge of the past has at all times been desired only in the service of the future and the present and not for the weakening of the present or for depriving a vigorous future of its roots: all this is simple, as the truth is simple, and will at once be obvious even to him who has not had it demonstrated by historical proof. And now let us quickly take a look at our own time! We are startled, we shy away: where has all the clarity, all the naturalness and purity of this relationship between life and history gone? in what restless and exaggerated confusion does this problem now swell before our eyes! Does the fault lie with us, who observe it? Or has the constellation of life and history really altered through the interposition of a mighty, hostile star between them? Let others show that we have seen falsely: for our part we shall say what we think we see. And what we see is certainly a star, a gleaming and glorious star interposing itself, the constellation really has been altered - by science, by the demand that history should be a science. Now the demands of life alone no longer reign and exercise constraint on knowledge of the past: now all the frontiers have been torn down and all that has ever been rushes upon mankind. All perspectives have been shifted back to the beginning of all becoming, back into infinity. Such an immense spectacle as the science of universal becoming, history, now displays has never before been seen by any generation; though it displays it, to be sure, with the perilous daring of its motto: *fiat veritas, 'pereat vita.'* Let us now picture the spiritual occurrence introduced into the soul of modern man by that which we have just described. Historical knowledge streams in unceasingly from inexhaustible wells, the strange and incoherent forces its way forward, memory opens all its gates and yet is not open wide enough, nature travails in an effort to receive, arrange and honour these strange guests, but they themselves are in

conflict with one another and it seems necessary to constrain and control them if one is not oneself to perish in their conflict. Habituation to such a disorderly, stormly and conflict ridden household gradually becomes a second nature, though this second nature is beyond question much weaker, much more restless, and thoroughly less sound than the first. In the end, modern man drags around with him a huge quantity of indigestible stones of knowledge, which then, as in the fairy tale, can sometimes be heard rumbling about inside him. And in this rumbling there is betrayed the most characteristic quality of modern man: the remarkable antithesis between an interior which fails to correspond to any exterior and an exterior which fails to correspond to any interior - an antithesis unknown to the peoples of earlier times. Knowledge, consumed for the greater part without hunger for it and even counter to one's needs, now no longer acts as an agent for transforming the outside world but remains concealed within a chaotic inner world which modern man describes with a curious pride as his uniquely characteristic inwardness. It is then said that one possesses content and only form is lacking; but such an antithesis is quite improper when applied to living things. This precisely is why our modern culture is not a living thing: it is incomprehensible without recourse to that antithesis; it is not a real culture at all but only a kind of knowledge of culture; it has an idea of and feeling for culture but no true cultural achievement emerges from them. What actually inspires it and then appears as a visible act, on the other hand, often signifies not much more than an indifferent convention, a pitiful imitation or even a crude caricature. Cultural sensibility then lies quietly within, like a snake that has swallowed rabbits whole and now lies in the sun and avoids all unnecessary movement. The inner process is now the thing itself, is what actually constitutes 'culture'. *"fiat veritas, pereat vita: let truth prevail though life perish"* On the uses and disadvantages of history for life. Anyone observing this has only one wish, that such a culture should not perish of indigestion. Imagine, for example, a Greek observing such a culture: he would perceive that for modern man 'educated' and 'historically educated' seem so to belong together as to mean one and the same thing and to differ only verbally. If he then said that one can be very educated and yet at the same time altogether uneducated historically, modern men would think they had failed to hear him aright and would shake their heads. That celebrated little nation of a not so distant past - I mean these same Greeks during the period of their greatest strength kept a tenacious hold on their unhistorical sense; if a present-day man were magically transported back to that world he would probably consider the Greeks very 'uncultured' - whereby, to be sure, the secret of modern culture, so scrupulously hidden, would be exposed to public ridicule: for we moderns have nothing whatever of our own; only by replenishing and cramming ourselves with the ages, customs, arts, philosophies, religions, discoveries of others do we become anything worthy of notice, that is

to say, walking encyclopaedias, which is what an ancient Greek transported into our own time would perhaps take us for. With encyclopaedias, however, all the value lies in what is contained within, in the content, not in what stands without, the binding and cover; so it is that the whole of modern culture is essentially inward: on the outside the bookbinder has printed some such thing as 'Handbook of inward culture for outward barbarians'. This antithesis of inner and outer, indeed, makes the exterior even more barbaric than it would be if a rude nation were only to develop out of itself in accordance with its own uncouth needs. For what means are available to nature for overcoming that which presses upon it in too great abundance? One alone: to embrace it as lightly as possible so as quickly to expel it again and have done with it. From this comes a habit of no longer taking real things seriously, from this arises the 'weak personality' by virtue of which the real and existent makes only a slight impression; one becomes ever more negligent of one's outer appearance and, provided the memory is continually stimulated by a stream of new things worth knowing which can be stored tidily away in its coffers, one finally widens the dubious gulf between content and form to the point of complete insensibility to barbarism. The culture of a people as the antithesis to this barbarism was once, and as I think with a certain justice, defined as unity of artistic style in all the expressions of the life of a people; this definition should not be misunderstood in the sense of implying an I.;": } ! l, \ ' i ! : < ; antithesis between barbarism and fine style; what is meant is that a people to whom one attributes a culture has to be in all reality a single living unity and not fall wretchedly apart into inner and outer, content and form. He who wants to strive for and promote the culture of a people should strive for and promote this higher unity and join in the destruction of modern bogus cultivated ness for the sake of a true culture; he should venture to reflect how the health of a people undermined by the study of history may be again restored, how it may rediscover its instincts and therewith its honesty. I may as well speak directly of ourselves, we Germans of the present day who are more afflicted than other nations by that weakness of personality and that contradiction between form and content. Form generally counts with us as a convention, as a vestment and disguise, and it is therefore, if not exactly hated, at any rate not loved; it would be even more correct to say that we have an extraordinary fear of the word 'convention' and, no doubt, also of the thing. It was this fear which led the German to desert the school of France: he wanted to become more natural and thereby mOJie German. But this 'thereby' seems to have been a miscalculation: escaped from the school of convention, he then let himself go in whatever manner his fancy happened to suggest to him, and at bottom did no more than imitate in a slovenly and half-forgetful way what he had formerly imitated with scrupulous care and often with success. So it is that, compared with past ages, we dwell even today in a carelessly inaccurate copy of French convention: a fact to

which all our comings and goings, conversations, clothing and habitations bear witness. We thought we were retreating into naturalness, but what we were really doing was letting ourselves go and electing for ease and comfort and the smallest possible degree of self-discipline. Take a stroll through a German city - compared with the distinct national qualities displayed in foreign cities, all the conventions here are negative ones, everything is colourless, worn out, badly copied, negligent, everyone does as he likes but what he likes is never forceful and well considered but follows the rules laid down first by universal haste, then by the universal rage for ease and comfort. A garment which costs no intelligence to design and no time to put on, that is to say a garment borrowed from abroad and imitated in the most easygoing way possible, at once counts with the Germans as a contribution to German national dress. The sense of form is rejected without the slightest misgiving - for we possess the sense of the content: for the On the uses and disadvantages of history for life Germans are, after all, celebrated for their profound inwardness. But this inwardness also carries with it a celebrated danger: the content itself, of which it is assumed that it cannot be seen from without, may occasionally evaporate; from without, however, neither its former presence nor its disappearance will be apparent at all. But however far from this danger we may imagine the German people to be, the foreigner will still be to some extent justified in maintaining that our interior is too feeble and disorganized to produce an outward effect and endow itself with a form. The interior of the Germans can be receptive to an exceptional degree: serious, powerful, profound, and perhaps even richer than that of other nations; but as a whole it remains weak because all these beautiful threads are not wound together into a powerful knot: so that the visible act is not the act and self-revelation of the totality of this interior but only a feeble or crude attempt on the part of one or other of these threads to pose as being the whole. That is why the German cannot be judged by his actions and why as an individual he is still completely hidden even after he has acted. As is well known, he has to be assessed according to his thoughts and feelings, and these he nowadays expresses in his books. If only it were not precisely these books which, now more than ever before, lead us to doubt whether that celebrated inwardness really does still reside in its inaccessible little temple; it is a dreadful thought that one day they might disappear and all that would be left to signalize" the German would be his arrogantly clumsy and meekly slovenly exterior: almost as dreadful as if that hidden inwardness were sitting in there falsified and painted over and had become an actor if not something worse. This, at any rate, is what Grillparzer, as an independent observer, seems to have gathered from his experience in the theatre. 'We feel in abstractions', he says, 'we hardly know any longer how feeling really expresses itself with our contemporaries; we show them performing actions such as they no longer perform nowadays. Shakespeare has

ruined all of us moderns.' This is a single case and perhaps it has been generalized too hastily: but how fearful it would be if such a generalization were justified, if a host of individual cases should crowd in upon the observer; how desolating it would be to have to say: we Germans feel in abstractions, we have all been ruined by history - a proposition which would destroy at its roots all hope of a future national culture: for any such hope grows out of the belief in the genuineness and immediacy of German feeling, out of the belief in a sound and whole inwardness. What is there left to hope for or believe in if the source of hope and belief is muddled, if inwardness has learned to make leaps, to dance, to paint itself, to express itself in abstractions and with calculation and gradually to lose itself? And how should the great productive spirit continue to endure among a people no longer secure in a unified inwardness and which falls asunder into the cultivated with a miseducated and misled inwardness on the one hand and the uncultivated with an inaccessible inwardness on the other! How should that spirit endure if unity of feeling among the people has been lost, and if, moreover, it knows that this feeling is falsified and retouched precisely among that part of the people which calls itself the cultured part and lays claim to possession of the national artistic conscience? Even if here and there an individual's taste and judgment has grown more subtle and sublimated, that is no advantage to him: he is racked by the knowledge that he has to speak as it were to a sect and is no longer needed in the body of his nation. Perhaps he now prefers to bury his treasure rather than suffer the disgust of being presumptuously patronized by a sect while his heart is full of pity for all. The instinct of the nation no longer comes out to meet him; it is useless for him to stretch out his arms towards them in longing. What is there now left to this spirit but to turn his inspired hatred against that constraint, against the barriers erected in the so called culture of his nation, so as to condemn what to him, as a living being and one productive of life, is destructive and degrading: thus he exchanges a profound insight into his destiny for the divine joys of creation and construction, and ends as a solitary man of knowledge and satiated sage. It is the most painful of spectacles: he who beholds it will know a sacred compulsion: here, he says to himself, I must render aid, that higher unity in the nature and soul of a people must again be created, that breach between inner and outer must again vanish under the hammer-blows of necessity. But what weapons can he employ? What does he have but, again, his profound insight: propagating it and sowing it with full hands he hopes to implant a need: and out of a vigorous need there will one day arise a vigorous deed. And so as to leave no doubt of the source of my example of that need, that necessity, that perception, let me say expressly that it is for German unity in that highest sense that we strive, and strive more ardently than we do for political reunification, the unity of German 'spirit and life after the abolition of the antithesis of form and content, of inwardness and convention. - On the uses and

disadvantages of history for life The oversaturation of an age with history seems to me to be hostile and dangerous to life in five respects: such an excess creates that contrast between inner and outer which we have just discussed, and thereby weakens the personality; it leads an age to imagine that it possesses the rarest of virtues, justice, to a greater degree than any other age; it disrupts the instincts of a people, and hinders the individual no less than the whole in the attainment of maturity; it implants the belief, harmful at any time, in the old age of mankind, the belief that one is a latecomer and epigone; it leads an age into a dangerous mood of irony in regard to itself and subsequently into the even more dangerous mood of cynicism: in this mood, however, it develops more and more a prudent practical egoism through which the forces of life are paralyzed and at last destroyed. And now back to our first proposition: modern man suffers from a weakened personality. As the Roman of the imperial era became un-Roman in relation to the world which stood at his service, as he lost himself in the flood of foreigners which came streaming in and degenerated in the midst of the cosmopolitan carnival of gods, arts and customs, so the same must happen to modern man who allows his artists in history to go on 'preparing a world exhibition for him; he has become a strolling spectator and has arrived at a condition in which even great wars and revolutions are able to influence him for hardly more than a moment. The war is not even over before it is transformed into a hundred thousand printed pages and set before the tired palates of the history-hungry as the latest delicacy. It seems that the instrument is almost incapable of producing a strong and full note, no matter how vigorously it is played: its tones at once die away and in a moment have faded to a tender historical echo. Expressed morally: you are no longer capable of holding on to the sublime, your deeds are short-lived explosions, not rolling thunder. Though the greatest and most miraculous event should occur it must nonetheless descend, silent and unsung, into Hades. For art flees away if you immediately conceal your deeds under the awning of history. He who wants to understand, grasp and assess in a moment that before which he ought to stand long in awe as before an incomprehensible sublimity may be called reasonable, but only in the sense in which Schiller speaks of the rationality of the reasonable man: there are things he does not see which even a child sees, there are things he does not hear which even a child hears, and these things are precisely the most important things: because he does not understand these things, his understanding is more childish than the child and more simple than simplicity - and this in spite of the many cunning folds of his parchment scroll and the virtuosity of his fingers in unravelling the entangled. The reason is that he has lost and destroyed his instincts and, having lost his trust in the 'divine animal', he can no longer let go the reins when his reason falters and his path leads him through deserts. Thus the individual grows fainthearted and unsure and dares no longer believe in himself:

he sinks into his own interior depths, which here means into the accumulated lumber of what he has learned but which has no outward effect, of instruction which does not become life. If one watches him from outside, one sees how the expulsion of the instincts by history has transformed man almost into mere abstracts and shadows: no one dares to appear as he is, but masks himself as a cultivated man, as a scholar, as a poet, as a politician. If, believing all this to be in earnest and not a mere puppet-play - for they all affect earnestness - one takes hold of these riddles, one suddenly has nothing but rags and tatters in one's hands. That is why one should no longer let oneself be deceived, that is why one should order them: 'Off with your coats or be what you seem!' It can no longer be borne that everyone of a noble seriousness should become a Don Quixote: since he has better things to do than to buffet about with such false realities. But he must nonetheless keep a sharp lookout, whenever he encounters a mask cry his 'Halt! Who goes there?' and tear the mask from its face. Strange! One would think that history would encourage men to be honest - even if only honest fools; and hitherto this has indeed been its effect, only now it is no longer! Historical education and the identical bourgeois coat rule at the same time. While the 'free personality' has never before been commended so volubly, there are no personalities to be seen, let alone free personalities nothing but anxiously muffled up identical people. Individuality has withdrawn within: from without it has become invisible; a fact which leads one to ask whether indeed there could be causes without effects. Or is a race of eunuchs needed to watch over the great historical world-harem? Pure objectivity would certainly characterize such a race. For it almost seems that the task is to stand guard over history to see that nothing comes out of it except more history, and certainly no real events! - to take care that history does not make any personality 'free', that is to say truthful towards itself, truthful towards others, in both word and deed. It is only through the uses and disadvantages of history for life such truthfulness that the distress, the inner misery, of modern man will come to light, and that, in place of that anxious concealment through convention and masquerade, art and religion, true ancillaries will be able to combine to implant a culture which corresponds to real needs and does not, as present-day universal education teaches it to do, deceive itself as to these needs and thereby become a walking lie. In an age which suffers from this universal education, to what an unnatural, artificial and in any case unworthy state must the most truthful of all sciences, the honest naked goddess philosophy, be reduced! In such a world of compelled external uniformity it must remain the learned monologue of the solitary walker, the individual's chance capture, the hidden secret of the chamber, or the harmless chatter of academic old men and children. No one dares venture to fulfil the philosophical law in himself, no one lives philosophically with that simple loyalty that constrained a man of antiquity to bear himself as a Stoic wherever he

was, whatever he did, once he had affirmed his loyalty to the Stoa. All modern philosophizing is political and official, limited by governments, churches, academies, customs and the cowardice of men to the appearance of scholarship; it sighs 'if only' or knows 'there once was' and does nothing else. Within a historical culture philosophy possesses no rights if it wants to be more than a self-restrained knowing which leads to no action; if modern man had any courage or resolution at all, if he were not merely a subjective creature even in his enmities, he would banish philosophy; as it is, he contents himself with modestly concealing its nudity. One may think, write, print, speak, teach philosophy - to that point more or less everything is permitted; only in the realm of action, of so-called life, is it otherwise: there only one thing is ever permitted and everything else simply impossible: thus will historical culture have it. Are there still human beings, one then asks oneself, or perhaps only thinking-, writing- and speaking-machines? Goethe once said of Shakespeare: 'No one despised outward costume more than he; he knew very well the inner human costume, and here all are alike. They say he hit off the Romans admirably; but I don't find it so, they are all nothing but flesh-and-blood Englishmen, but they are certainly human beings, human from head to foot, and the Roman toga sits on them perfectly well.' Now I ask whether it would be possible to represent our contemporary men of letters, popular figures, officials or politicians as Romans; it simply would not work, because they are not human beings but only -I I: flesh-and-blood compendia and as it were abstractions made concrete. If they possess a character of their own it is buried so deep it cannot get out into the light of day: if they are human beings they are so only to him 'who explores the depths'. To anyone else they are something different, not men, not gods, not animals, but creations of historical culture, wholly structure, image, form without demonstrable content and, unhappily, ill-designed form and, what is more, uniform. And so let my proposition be understood and pondered: history can be borne only by strong personalities, weak ones are utterly extinguished by it. The reason is that history confuses the feelings and sensibility when these are not strong enough to assess the past by themselves. He who no longer dares to trust himself but involuntarily asks of history 'How ought I to feel about this?' finds that his timidity gradually turns him into an actor and that he is playing a role, usually indeed many roles and therefore playing them badly and superficially. Gradually all congruity between the man and his historical domain is lost; we behold pert little fellows associating with the Romans as though they were their equals: and they root and burrow in the remains of the Greek poets as though these too were corpora for their dissection and were as vilia as their own literary corpora may be. * Suppose one of them is engaged with Democritus, I always feel like asking: why not Heraclitus? Or Philo? Or Bacon? Or Descartes? or anyone else. And then: why does it have to be a philosopher? Why not a poet or

an orator? And: why a Greek at all, why not an Englishman or a Turk? Is the past not big enough for you to be able to find nothing except things in comparison with which you cut so ludicrous a figure? But, as I have said, this is a race of eunuchs, and to a eunuch one woman is like another, simply a woman, woman in herself, the eternally unapproachable and it is thus a matter of indifference what they do so long as history itself is kept nice and 'objective', bearing in mind that those who want to keep it so are for ever incapable of making history themselves. And since the eternally womanly will never draw you upward, you draw it down to you and, being neuters, take history too for a neuter. t But so that it shall not be thought that I am seriously comparing history *vilia corpora: vile bodies t Alludes to the closing lines of Goethe's *Faust II*: 'Das Ewig-Weibliche/ Zieht uns hinan'. Nietzsche often alludes to the phrase, always in an ironic-humorous tone: he fait('d, I think, to discover any meaning in it. On the uses and disadvantages of history for life with the eternally womanly, I should like to make it clear that, on the contrary, I regard it rather as the eternally manly: though, to be sure, for those who are 'historically educated' through and through it must be a matter of some indifference whether it is the one or the other: for they themselves are neither man nor woman, nor even hermaphrodite, but always and only neuters or, to speak more cultivatedly, the eternally objective. If the personality is emptied in the manner described and has become eternally subjectless or, as it is usually put, objective, nothing can affect it any longer; good and right things may be done, as deeds, poetry, music: the hollowed-out cultivated man at once looks beyond the work and asks about the history of its author. If he has already several other works behind him, he is at once obliged to have explained to him the previous and possible future progress of his development, he is at once compared with other artists, criticized as to his choice of subject and his treatment of it, dissected, carefully put together again, and in general admonished and set on the right path. The most astonishing thing may come to pass the host of the historically neutral is always there ready to supervise the author of it even while he is still far off. The echo is heard immediately: but always as a 'critique', though the moment before the critic did not so much as dream of the possibility of what has been done. The work never produces an effect but only another 'critique'; and the critique itself produces no effect either, but again only a further critique. There thus arises a general agreement to regard the acquisition of many critiques as a sign of success, of few or none as a sign of failure. At bottom, however, even given this kind of 'effect' everything remains as it was: people have some new thing to chatter about for a while, and then something newer still, and in the meantime go on doing what they have always done. The historical culture of our critics will no longer permit any effect at all in the proper sense, that is an effect on life and action: their blotting-paper at once goes down even on the blackest writing, and across the most graceful design they

smear their thick brush-strokes which are supposed to be regarded as corrections: and once again that is the end of that. But their critical pens never cease to flow, for they have lost control of them and instead of directing them are directed by them. It is precisely in this immoderation of its critical outpourings, in its lack of self-control, in that which the Romans call *impotentia*, that the modern personality betrays its weakness. 8 7 But let us leave this weakness behind; and let us turn to a much celebrated strength of modern man with the question, a painful one to be sure, as to whether on account of his well-known historical 'objectivity' he has a right to call himself strong, that is to say just, and just in a higher degree than men of other ages. Is it true that this objectivity originates in an enhanced need and demand for justice? Or is it an effect of quite different causes and only appears to originate in a desire for justice? Does it perhaps seduce one to a harmful, because all too flattering, prejudice as to the virtues of modern man? Socrates considered that to delude oneself that one possesses a virtue one does not possess is an illness bordering on madness: and such a delusion is certainly more dangerous than the opposite illusion of being the victim of a fault or a vice. For in the latter case it is at any rate possible one will become better; the former delusion, however, makes a man or an age daily worse - which in the present instance means more unjust. In truth, no one has a greater claim to our veneration than he who possesses the drive to and strength for justice. For the highest and rarest virtues are united and concealed in justice as in an unfathomable ocean that receives streams and rivers from all sides and takes them into itself. The hand of the just man who is empowered to judge no longer trembles when it holds the scales; he sets weight upon weight with inexorable disregard of himself, his eye is unclouded as it sees the scales rise and fall, and his voice is neither harsh nor tearful when he pronounces the verdict. If he were a cold demon of knowledge, he would spread about him the icy atmosphere of a dreadful suprahuman majesty which we would have to fear, not revere: but that he is a human being and yet none the less tries to ascend from indulgent doubt to stern certainty, from tolerant mildness to the imperative 'you must', from the rare virtue of magnanimity to the rarest of all virtues, justice; that he resembles that demon but is from the start only a poor human being; and above all that he has every moment to atone for his humanity and is tragically consumed by an impossible virtue - all this sets him on a solitary height as the most venerable exemplar of the species man; for he desires truth, not as cold, ineffectual knowledge, but as a regulating and punishing judge; truth, not as the egoistic possession of the individual, but as the sacred right to overturn all the boundary stones of egoistic possessions; in a word, truth as the Last Judgment and not, for instance, as the prey joyfully seized by the individual huntsman. Only insofar as the truthful man possesses the On the uses and disadvantages of history for life unconditional will to justice is there anything great in that striving for truth

which is everywhere so thoughtlessly glorified: whereas in the eyes of less clear-sighted men a whole host of the most various drives - curiosity, flight from boredom, envy, vanity, the desire for amusement, for example - can be involved in the striving for truth, though in reality they have nothing whatever to do with truth, which has its roots in justice. Thus the world seems to be full of those who 'serve truth', yet the virtue of justice is rarely present, even more rarely recognized and almost always mortally hated: while on the other hand the horde of those who only appear virtuous is at all times received with pomp and honour. The truth is that few serve truth because few possess the pure will to justice, and of these few only a few also possess the strength actually to be just. To possess only the will is absolutely not enough: and the most terrible sufferings sustained by mankind have proceeded precisely from those possessing the drive to justice but lacking the power of judgment; which is why nothing would promote the general wellbeing more mightily than to sow the seeds of correct judgment as widely as possible, so that the fanatic would be distinguished from the judge and the blind desire to be a judge from the conscious ability to judge. But where could a means of implanting the power of judgment be found! - man will always remain in doubt and trepidation whether, when truth and justice are spoken of, it is a fanatic or a judge who is speaking to them. That is why they must be forgiven if they have always extended an especially cordial welcome to those 'servants of truth' who possess neither the will nor the power to judge and set themselves the task of seeking 'pure, self-subsistent' knowledge or, more clearly, truth that eventuates in nothing. There are very many truths that are a matter of complete indifference; there are problems whose just solution does not demand even an effort, let alone a sacrifice. In this region of indifference and absence of danger a man may well succeed in becoming a cold demon of knowledge: and nonetheless, even if in favourable times whole cohorts of scholars and inquirers are transformed into such demons - it will always fortunately be possible that such an age will suffer from a lack of a stern and great sense of justice, that is, of the noblest centre of the so-called drive to truth. Now picture to yourself the historical virtuoso of the present day: is he the justest man of his time? It is true he has developed in him self such a tenderness and susceptibility of feeling that nothing human is alien to him; the most various ages and persons continue to sound in kindred notes on the strings of his lyre: he has become a passive sounding-board whose reflected tones act upon other similar sounding-boards: until at last the whole air of an age is filled with the confused humming of these tender and kindred echoes. Yet it seems to me as though only the harmonics of the original historical note are audible: the solidity and power of the original can no longer be divined in the shrill and bubble-thin vibrations of these strings. The original note recalled actions, distress, terrors; this note lulls us and makes of us tame spectators; it is as though the 'Eroica' Symphony had been arranged for two

flutes for the entertainment of drowsy opium-smokers. Through this we are already in a position to assess how these virtuosi will stand in regard to modern man's supreme claim to a higher and purer sense of justice; this virtue never has anything pleasing about it, knows no delicious tremors, is harsh and dread-inspiring. In comparison, how low even magnanimity stands in the scale of the virtues, and magnanimity is itself possessed by only a few rare historians! Many more of them attain only to tolerance, to allowing validity to what they cannot deny happened, to explaining away and extenuating, on the correct assumption that the inexperienced will interpret the mere absence of abrasiveness and harsh condemnation of the past as evidence of a just disposition. But only superior strength can judge, weakness is obliged to tolerate if it is not to make a hypocritical pretence of strength and turn justice sitting in judgment into an actor. There still remains a dreadful species of historian, efficient, severe and honest of character but narrow of mind; the will to be just is there, as is the pathos attending the office of judge: but all their verdicts are false, for approximately the same reason as the verdicts of ordinary court juries are false. How improbable it thus is that there should be an abundance of talent for history! Quite apart from the disguised egoists and party men who employ an air of objectivity in furtherance of their crooked game. And quite apart also from those wholly thoughtless people who when they write history do so in the naive belief that all the popular views of precisely their own age are the right and just views and that to write in accord with the views of their age is the same thing as being just; a belief in which every religion dwells and about which in the case of religions no further comment is needed. These naive historians call the assessment of the opinions and deeds of the past according to the everyday standards of the present moment 'objectivity': it is here they discover the canon of all truth; their task is to adapt the past to contemporary triviality. On the other hand, they on the uses and disadvantages of history for life call all historiography 'subjective' that does not accept these popular standards as canonical. And may an illusion not creep into the word objectivity even in its highest interpretation? According to this interpretation, the word means a condition in the historian which permits him to observe an "event in all its motivations and consequences so purely that it has no effect at all on his own subjectivity: it is analogous to that aesthetic phenomenon of detachment from personal interest with which a painter sees in a stormy landscape with thunder and lightning, or a rolling sea, only the picture of them within him, the phenomenon of complete absorption in the things themselves: it is a superstition, however, that the picture which these things evoke in a man possessing such a disposition is a true reproduction of the empirical nature of the things themselves. Or is it supposed that at this moment the things as it were engrave, counterfeit, photograph themselves by their own action on a purely passive

medium? This would be mythology, and bad mythology at that: and it is forgotten, moreover, that that moment is precisely the strongest and most spontaneous moment of creation in the depths of the artist, a moment of composition of the highest sort, the outcome of which may be an artistically true painting but cannot be an historically true one. To think of history objectively in this fashion is the silent work of the dramatist; that is to say, to think of all things in relation to all others and to weave the isolated event into the whole: always with the presupposition that if a unity of plan does not already reside in things it must be implanted into them. Thus man spins his web over the past and subdues it, thus he gives expression to his artistic drive but not to his drive towards truth or justice. Objectivity and justice have nothing to do with one another. A historiography could be imagined which had in it not a drop of common empirical truth and yet could lay claim to the highest degree of objectivity. Indeed, Grillparzer ventures to declare: 'What is history but the way in which the spirit of man apprehends events impenetrable to him; unites things when God alone knows whether they belong together; substitutes something comprehensible for what is incomprehensible; imposes his concept of purpose from without upon a whole which, if it possesses a purpose, does so only inherently; and assumes the operation of chance where a thousand little causes have been at work. All human beings have at the same time their own individual necessity, so that millions of courses run parallel beside one another in straight or crooked lines, frustrate or advance one another, strive forwards or backwards, and thus assume for one another the character of chance, and so, quite apart from the influence of the occurrences of nature, make it impossible to establish any all-embracing necessity prevailing throughout all events.' But it is exactly this kind of necessity that is supposed to be brought to light as the result of that 'objective' view of things! This is a presupposition which, if enunciated by an historian as an article of faith, would assume a very strange shape; Schiller is quite clear as to the purely subjective nature of this assumption when he says of the historian: 'one phenomenon after another begins to forsake the realm of blind chance and limitless freedom and to take its place as a fitting member of a harmonious whole - which whole is, of course, present only in his imagination', But what is one to make of this assertion, hovering as it does between tautology and nonsense, by one celebrated historical virtuoso: 'the fact of the matter is that all human actions are subject to the mighty and irresistible direction of the course of things, though it may often not be apparent'? Such a proposition is not, as it might perhaps seem, enigmatic wisdom in the shape of plain foolishness, as when Goethe's court gardener says 'Nature may let itself be forced but it cannot be compelled', or in the fairground placard reported by Swift: 'Here can be seen the biggest elephant in the world except itself.' For how are human actions and the course of things to be distinguished from one another? It seems to me in

general that historians such as the one we have just quoted cease to instruct as soon as they begin to generalize and then reveal the weakness they feel in the dark obscurities they employ. In other sciences the generalizations are the most important thing, inasmuch as they contain the laws: but if such propositions as that quoted are intended to count as laws, then one must object that in that case the work of the historiographer is wasted; for whatever truth remains in such propositions after the obscurities referred to have been removed is something completely familiar and even trivial; for it will be obvious to everyone through every kind of experience down to the very smallest. To incommode whole nations and expend years of wearisome toil on it, however, is merely to pile experiment upon experiment long after the law intended to be extracted from them has been amply demonstrated: a senseless excess of experimentation which has in fact plagued the natural sciences since the time of Zollner. If the value of a drama lay solely in its conclusion, the drama itself would be merely the most wearisome and indirect way possible of reaching this goal; and so I hope that the significance of history. On the uses and disadvantages of history for life will not be thought to lie in its general propositions, as if these were the flower and fruit of the whole endeavour, but that its value will be seen to consist in its taking a familiar, perhaps commonplace theme, an everyday melody, and composing inspired variations on it, enhancing it, elevating it to a comprehensive symbol; and thus disclosing in the original theme a whole world of profundity, power and beauty. For this, however, there is required above all great artistic facility, creative vision, loving absorption in the empirical data, the capacity to imagine the further development of a given type - in any event, objectivity is required, but as a positive quality. So often objectivity is only a phrase. Instead of the outwardly tranquil but inwardly flashing eye of the artist there is the affectation of tranquillity; just as a lack of feeling and moral strength is accustomed to disguise itself as incisive coldness and detachment. In certain cases banality of ideas, the everyday wisdom which seems calm and tranquil only because it is tedious, ventures to pose as that artistic condition in which the subject becomes silent and wholly imperceptible. What is then preferred is that which produces no emotion at all and the driest phrase is the right phrase. One goes so far, indeed, as to believe that he to whom a moment of the past means nothing at all is the proper man to describe it. This is frequently the relationship between classicists and the Greeks they study: they mean nothing to one another - a state of affairs called 'objectivity'! It is precisely where the highest and rarest is to be represented that this ostentatious indifference becomes most infuriating - for it is the vanity of the historian which is responsible for it. Such authors incline one to agree with the proposition that a man possesses vanity to the degree that he lacks understanding. No, at any rate be honest! Do not seek the appearance of justice if you are not called to the dreadful vocation of the just man. As though it were the

task of every age to have to be just towards everything that has ever existed! It could even be said that ages and generations never do have the right to judge previous ages and generations: such an uncomfortable mission falls only to individuals, and these of the rarest kind. Who compels you to judge? And, moreover test your self to see whether you could be just if you wanted to be! As judge, you must stand higher than he who is to be judged; whereas all you are is subsequent to him. The guests who come last to table have to be content with the last places: and do you want the first? Then at least perform some high and great deed; perhaps then they really will make room for you, even if you do come last. If you are to venture to interpret the past you can do so only out of the fullest exertion of the vigour of the present: only when you put forth your noblest qualities in all their strength will you divine what is worth knowing and preserving in the past. Like to like! Otherwise you will draw the past down to you. Do not believe historiography that does not spring from the head of the rarest minds; and you will know the quality of a mind when it is obliged to express something universal or to repeat something universally known: the genuine historian must possess the power to remind the universally known into something never heard of before, and to express the universal so simply and profoundly that the simplicity is lost in the profundity and the profundity in the simplicity. No one can be a great historian, an artist and a shallow pate at the same time: on the other hand, one should not underrate the workmen who sift and carry merely because they can certainly never become great historians; but even less should one confuse them with them, but regard them rather as the necessary apprentices and handymen in the service of the master: much as the French used, with greater naivety than is possible to a German, to speak of the historiens de M. Thiers. These workmen are gradually to become great scholars, but cannot for that reason ever be masters. A great scholar and a great shallowpate these two go rather better under one hat. To sum up: history is written by the experienced and superior man. He who has not experienced greater and more exalted things than others will not know how to interpret the great and exalted things of the past. When the past speaks it always speaks as an oracle: only if you are an architect of the future and know the present will you understand it. The extraordinary degree and extent of the influence exercised by Delphi is nowadays explained principally by the fact that the Delphic priests had an exact knowledge of the past; now it would be right to say that only he who constructs the future has a right to judge the past. If you look ahead and set yourself a great goal, you at the same time restrain that rank analytical impulse which makes the present into a desert and all tranquillity, all peaceful growth and maturing almost impossible. Draw about yourself the fence of a great and comprehensive hope, of a hope-filled striving. Form within yourself an image to which the future shall correspond, and forget the superstition that you are

epigones. You will have enough to ponder and to invent when you reflect on the life of the future; but do not ask of history that it should show you the How? and the Wherewith? to this life. If, on the other hand, you acquire a On the uses and disadvantages of history for life living knowledge of the history of great men, you will learn from it a supreme commandment: to become mature and to flee from that paralyzing upbringing of the present age which sees its advantage in preventing your growth so as to rule and exploit you to the full while you are still immature. And if you want biographies, do not desire those which bear the legend 'Herr So-and-So and his age', but those upon whose title-page there would stand 'a fighter against his age'. Sate your soul with Plutarch and when you believe in his heroes dare at the same time to believe in yourself. With a hundred such men - raised in this unmodern way, that is to say become mature and accustomed to the heroic - the whole noisy sham-culture of our age could now be silenced for ever. - When the historical sense reigns without restraint, and all its consequences are realized, it uproots the future because it destroys illusions and robs the things that exist of the atmosphere in which alone they can live. Historical justice, even when it is genuine and practised with the purest of intentions, is therefore a dreadful virtue because it always undermines the living thing and brings it down: its judgment is always annihilating. If the historical drive does not also contain a drive to construct, if the purpose of destroying and clearing is not to allow a future already alive in anticipation to raise its house on the ground thus liberated, if justice alone prevails, then the instinct for creation will be enfeebled and discouraged. A religion, for example, which is intended to be transformed into historical knowledge under the hegemony of pure historical justice, a religion which is intended to be understood through and through as an object of science and learning, will when this process is at an end also be found to have been destroyed. The reason is that historical verification always brings to light so much that is false, crude, inhuman, absurd, violent that the mood of pious illusion in which alone any thing that wants to live can live necessarily crumbles away: for it is only in love, only when shaded by the illusion produced by love, that is to say in the unconditional faith in right and perfection, that man is creative. Anything that constrains a man to love less than unconditionally has severed the roots of his strength: he will wither away, that is to say become dishonest. In producing this effect, history is the antithesis of art: and only if history can endure to be transformed into a work of art will it perhaps be able to preserve instincts or even evoke them. Such a historiography would, however, be altogether contrary to the analytical and inartistic tendencies of our time, which would indeed declare it false. But a history which, lacking the direction of an inner drive to construct, does nothing but destroy, in the long run denaturizes its instruments: for such men destroy illusions and 'he who destroys the illusions in himself and others is punished by nature, the cruellest tyrant'. For

a good length of time, it is true, one can occupy oneself with history in a perfectly innocent and harmless way, as though it were merely an occupation like any other; recent theology especially seems to have entered into partnership with history out of pure innocence, and even now it almost refuses to see that, probably much against its will, it has thereby placed itself in the service of the Voltairean *ecrasez*. * No one should suppose that this development conceals a powerful new constructive instinct- unless, that is, one is to regard the so-called Protestant Union as the work of a new religion, and perhaps the jurist Holtzendorf (the editor and prefacer of the even more problematical Protestant Bible) as John the Baptist at the river Jordan. For some time yet the Hegelian philosophy still smouldering in older heads may assist in propagating this innocence, perhaps by teaching one how to distinguish the 'idea of Christianity' from its manifold imperfect 'phenomenal forms' and even to convince oneself that it is the 'preferred tendency of the idea' to reveal itself in ever purer forms, and at last in its purest, most transparent, indeed hardly visible form, in the brains of the contemporary theologus liberalis vulgaris. But when he hears these purest of-the-pure Christians speaking of earlier impure Christians the impartial auditor often has the impression that what is being spoken of is not Christianity at all but - well, what are we to think? When we find the 'greatest theologian of the century': characterizing Christianity as the religion which can 'discover itself in all existing and in several other barely possible religions', and when the 'true church' is supposed to be that which 'becomes a flowing mass, where there are no contours, where every part is now here, now there, and every thing blends peacefully together' - again, what are we to think? What one can learn in the case of Christianity that under the influence of a historical treatment it has become denaturalized, until a '*Voltairean *ecrasez*': alludes to Voltaire's motto '*ecrasez l'infame!*' - destroy the infamous thing (i.e. the Church). Protestant Union: the military alliance formed between 1608 and 1621 by the Protestant princes of Germany. :j:'greatest theologian of the century': Schleiermacher (see glossary). On the uses and disadvantages of history for life completely historical, that is to say just treatment resolves it into pure knowledge about Christianity and thereby destroys it - can be studied in everything else that possesses life: that it ceases to live when it is dissected completely, and lives a painful and morbid life when one begins to practise historical dissection upon it. There are people who believe that German music could have a transforming and reforming effect on the Germans: they are angered, and consider it an injustice against the most vigorous part of our culture, when they see such men as Mozart and Beethoven already engulfed by all the learned dust of biography and compelled by the torture instruments of historical criticism to answer a thousand impertinent questions. Does it not mean its premature death, or at least paralysis, when that, the living effects of which are not yet exhausted, is subjected to curious investigation of the countless

minutiae of its life and works, and when problems of knowledge are sought where one ought to learn to live and forget all problems? Imagine a couple of these modern biographers transported to the birthplace of Christianity or of the Lutheran Reformation; their sober, pragmatic curiosity would have exactly sufficed to render any act in distant impossible: just as the most wretched little animal can prevent the mightiest oak-tree from coming into existence by eating the acorn. All living things require an atmosphere around them, a mysterious misty vapour; if they are deprived of this envelope, if a religion, an art, a genius is condemned to revolve as a star without atmosphere, we should no longer be surprised if they quickly wither and grow hard and unfruitful. It is the same with all great things, 'which never succeed without some illusion', as Hans Sachs says in the *Meistersinger*. But every nation, too, indeed every human being that wants to become mature requires a similar enveloping illusion, a similar protective and veiling cloud; nowadays, however, maturity as such is hated because history is held in greater honour than life. There is, indeed, rejoicing that now 'science is beginning to dominate life': that condition may, possibly, be attained; but life thus dominated is not of much value because it is far less living and guarantees far less life for the future than did a former life dominated not by knowledge but by instinct and powerful illusions. But the present age is, as aforesaid, supposed to be an age, not of whole, mature and harmonious personalities, but of labour of the greatest possible common utility. That means, however, that men have to be adjusted to the purposes of the age so as to be ready for employment as soon as possible: they must labour in the factories of the generation. Good before they are mature, indeed so that they shall not become mature for this would be a luxury which would deprive the 'labour market' of a great deal of its workforce. Some birds are blinded so that they may sing more beautifully; I do not think the men of today sing more beautifully than their grandfathers, but I know they have been blinded. The means, the infamous means used to blind them, however, is too bright, too sudden, too varying light. The young man is swept along through all the millennia: youths who understand nothing of war, diplomatic action, commercial policy are thought fit to be introduced to political history. But as the youth races through his story, so do we modern men race through art galleries and listen to concerts. We feel that one thing sounds different from another, that one thing produces a different effect from another: increasingly to lose this sense of strangeness, no longer to be very much surprised at anything, finally to be pleased with everything - that is then no doubt called the historical sense, historical culture. To speak without euphemism: the mass of the influx is so great, the strange, barbaric and violent things that press upon the youthful soul do so with such overwhelming power that its only refuge is in an intentional stupidity. Where there has been a stronger and more subtle awareness, another emotion has no doubt also appeared: disgust. The young man has become so

homeless and doubts all concepts and all customs. He now knows: every age is different, it does not matter what you are like. In melancholy indifference he lets opinion after opinion pass him by and he understands how Hölderlin felt when he read Diogenes Laërtius on the lives and teachings of the Greek philosophers: 'I have again found here what I have often before discovered, that the transitoriness and changeableness of human thoughts and systems strike me as being almost more tragic than the destinies which alone are usually called real.' No, to be so overwhelmed and bewildered by history is, as the ancients demonstrate, not at all necessary for youth, but in the highest degree dangerous to it, as the moderns demonstrate. But now notice the actual student of history, the heir of an enfeeblement already visible almost before he has ceased to be a boy. He has acquired the 'methods' for doing work of his own, the right technique and the noble bearing of the master; a wholly isolated little chapter of the past has fallen victim to his astuteness and the methods he has learned; he has already produced, indeed to use a prouder word, he has 'created' something, he has now become an active servant of On the uses and disadvantages of history for life truth and a lord in the universal empire of history. If already as a boy he was 'ripe', now he is over-ripe: one needs only to shake him and wisdom comes clattering down into one's lap; but the wisdom is rotten and there is a worm in every apple. Believe me: if men are to labour and be useful in the factory of science before they are mature, science will soon be ruined just as effectively as the slaves thus employed too early. I regret the need to make use of the jargon of the slave-owner and employer of labour to describe things which in themselves ought to be thought of as free of utility and raised above the necessities of life; but the words 'factory', 'labour market', 'supply', 'making profitable', and whatever auxiliary verbs egoism now employs, come unbidden to the lips when one wishes to describe the most recent generation of men of learning. Sterling mediocrity grows even more mediocre, science ever more profitable in the economic sense. Actually our most recent men of learning are wise on one point, and on that they are, I admit, wiser than anyone has ever been, but on all other points they are infinitely different - to use a cautious expression - from any man of learning of the old stamp. This notwithstanding, they demand honours and advantages for themselves, as though the state and public opinion were duty bound to accept the new coins as being of equal value to the old. The carters have made a contract with one another and by restamping themselves as geniuses have decreed that genius is superfluous; probably a later age will see that their buildings are carted together, not constructed. Those who unwearyingly repeat the modern call to battle and sacrifice 'Division of labour! Fall in!' must for once be told in round and plain terms: if you want to push science forward as quickly as possible you will succeed in destroying it as quickly as possible; just as a hen perishes if it is compelled to lay eggs too

quickly. Science has certainly been pushed forward at an astonishing speed over the past decades: but just look at the men of learning, the exhausted hens. They are in truth not 'harmonious' natures; they can only cackle more than ever because they lay eggs more often: though the eggs, to be sure, have got smaller and smaller (though the books have got thicker and thicker). As the final and most natural outcome we have the universally admired 'popularization' (together with 'feminization' and 'infantization') of science, that is to say the infamous trimming of the coat of science to fit the body of the 'general public' - to employ a cutting expression for an activity suited to tailors. Goethe saw this as a misuse of science and demanded that the sciences should affect the outside world only through enhanced practical application. The older generation of men of learning, moreover, had -good grounds for regarding such a misuse as difficult and burdensome: it is on equally good grounds that the younger generation finds it easy, for, except in the case of a tiny corner of knowledge, they themselves are very much 'general public' and share its needs. They have only to sit at their ease for once and they are able to open to the curiosity of this general populace even the little realm of their own special study. This relaxation is afterwards called 'the man of learning modestly condescending to his people': while in reality the man of learning has, to the extent that he is not a man of learning but one of the mob, descended only to his own level. Create for your selves the concept of a 'people': it could never be too exalted or too noble a concept. If you thought well of the people you would show them compassion and would guard against offering them your his torical aqua fortis as a refreshing draught of life. But in your hearts you despise them, for you cannot bring yourself seriously to care about their future, and your behaviour is that of practical pessimists, by which I mean men directed by a presentiment of coming disaster and therefore sluggishly indifferent to the wellbeing of others and to your own as well. If only the ground will go on bearing us! And if it ceases to bear us, that too is very well: - that is their feeling and thus they live an ironic existence. It may seem strange, though it ought not to seem self-contradictory, when I ascribe a kind of ironic self-awareness to an age accustomed to break into such loud and innocent rejoicing at its historical culture, and say that it is infused with a presentiment that there is really nothing to rejoice about and a fear that all the merriment of historical knowledge will soon be over and done with. Goethe presented to us a comparable enigma in regard to the individual personality in his noteworthy account of Newton: he discovers at the foundation (or, more correctly, at the highest point) of his being 'a troubled presentiment that he is in error', the momentary expression, as it were, of a superior consciousness that has attained to a certain ironical overview of his inherent nature. So it is that we find in precisely the greatest and more highly developed historical men a suppressed consciousness, often amounting to a general scepticism, of how great an absurdity and superstition it is to believe that

the education of a nation has to be as preponderantly historical as it is now; for pre-1000 On the uses and disadvantages of history for precisely the most vigorous nations, vigorous in deeds and works, lived differently from this and raised their children differently. But that absurdity and superstition is suited to us - so runs the sceptical objection - to us, the latecomers, the last pale offspring of mightier and happier races, to us who are the fulfilment of Hesiod's prophesy that men would one day be born already grey-haired and that as soon as he saw that sign Zeus would eradicate this race. Historical culture is indeed a kind of inborn grey-hairedness, and those who bear its mark from childhood must instinctively believe in the old age of mankind: to age, however, there pertains an appropriate senile occupation, that of looking back, of reckoning up, of closing accounts, of seeking consolation through remembering what has been, in short historical culture. But the human race is a tough and persistent thing and will not permit its progress - forwards or back wards - to be viewed in terms of millennia, or indeed hardly in terms of hundreds of millennia; that is to say, it will not be viewed as a whole at all by that infinitesimal atom, the individual man. What is there in a couple of thousand years (or in other words the space of 34 consecutive generations of 60 years each) which permits us to speak of the 'youth' of mankind at the beginning and the 'old age' of mankind at the end? Is there not concealed in this paralysing belief that humanity is already declining a misunderstanding of a Christian theological idea inherited from the Middle Ages, the idea that the end of the world is coming, that we are fearfully awaiting the Last Judgment? Is the increasing need for historical judgment not that same idea in a new dress, as though our age, being the ultimate age, were empowered to exercise over all the past that universal judgment which Christian belief never supposed would be pronounced by men but by 'the Son of Man'? In earlier times this 'memento mori' addressed to mankind as a whole as well as to individual men was an ever-painful goad and as it were the high point of medieval learning and conscience. Its modern antithesis, 'memento vivere', is, to speak frankly, still a somewhat modest little sound rather than a full throated one, and has something almost dishonest about it. For mankind continues to treasure its memento mori and reveals the fact through its universal need for history: knowledge, its mightiest wing beats notwithstanding, has not been able to soar aloft, a profound sense of hopelessness remains and has assumed that historical colouring with which all higher education and culture is now saddened and darkened. A religion which of all the hours of a man's life holds the last to be the most important, which prophesies an end to all life on earth and condemns all who live to live in the fifth act of a tragedy, may well call forth the profoundest and noblest powers, but it is inimical to all new planting, bold experimentation, free aspiration; it resists all flight into the unknown because it loves and hopes for nothing there: it allows what is becoming to force its way up only with reluctance, and then when

the time is ripe it sacrifices it or sets it aside as a seducer to existence, as a liar as to the value of existence. What the Florentines did when, under the influence of Savonarola's preaching, they made that celebrated holocaust of paintings, manuscripts, mirrors and masks, Christianity would like to do to every culture which stimulates continued striving and bears that *memento vivere* as its motto; and if it proves impossible to do this in a blunt and direct manner, that is to say by force, it nonetheless achieves its aim by allying itself with historical culture, usually without the latter's knowledge moreover, and speaking henceforth through its mouth rejects with a shrug everything still coming into being and smothers it in the awareness of being a latecomer and epigone, in short of being born *grey-haire*. Austere and profoundly serious reflection on the worthlessness of all that has occurred, on the ripeness of the world for judgment, is dissipated into the sceptical . attitude that it is at any rate as well to know about all that has occurred, since it is too late to do anything better. Thus the historical sense makes its servants passive and retrospective; and almost the only time the sufferer from the fever of history becomes active is when this sense is in abeyance through momentary forgetfulness - . though even then, as soon as the act is finished he at once dissects it, prevents it from producing any further effects by analysing it, and finally skins it for the purpose of 'historical study'. In this sense we are still living in the Middle Ages and history is still disguised theology: just as the reverence with which the unlearned laity treat the learned \ class is inherited from the reverence with which it treated the clergy. What one formerly gave to the church one now gives, though more sparingly, to learning: but that one gives at all is an effect of the church's former influence - the modern spirit, as is well known, is somewhat niggardly and unskilled in the noble virtue of generosity. Perhaps this observation will not be very acceptable, perhaps as unacceptable as my derivation of our excess of history from the medieval *memento mori* and the hopelessness in regard to all coming ages of human existence which Christianity bears in its heart. If so, you might try to replace this explanation, which I offer only with some hesitation, with a better one; for the origin of historical culture On the uses and disadvantages of history for lift - its quite radical conflict with the spirit of any 'new age', any 'modern awareness' - this origin must itself be known historically, history must itself resolve the problem of history, knowledge must turn its sting against itself - this threefold must is the imperative of the 'new age', supposing this age really does contain anything new, powerful, original and promising more life. Or is it actually the case that we Germans to leave the Romance nations out of account - must always be no more than 'heirs' in all the higher affairs of culture, because that is all we can ever be; a proposition once memorably expressed by Wilhelm Wackernagel: 'We Germans are a nation of heirs, with all our higher knowledge, even with our beliefs, no more than heirs of the world of antiquity; even those hostile to it continually breathe the immortal

spirit of classical culture beside the spirit of Christianity, and if anyone succeeded in excluding these two elements from the atmosphere which surrounds the inner world of man there would not be much left to prolong a life of the spirit.' And even if we Germans were really no more than heirs - to be able to look upon such a culture as that as our rightful inheritance would make the appellation 'heirs' the greatest and proudest possible: yet we would nonetheless be obliged to ask whether it really was our eternal destiny to be pupils of declining antiquity: at some time or other we might be permitted gradually to set our goal higher and more distant, some time or other we ought to be allowed to claim credit for having developed the spirit of Alexandrian-Roman culture so nobly and fruitfully among other means through our universal history that we might now as a reward be permitted to set ourselves the even mightier task of striving to get behind and beyond this Alexandrian world and boldly to seek our models in the original ancient Greek world of greatness, naturalness and humanity. But there we also discover the reality of an essentially unhistorical culture and one which is nonetheless, or rather on that account, an inexpressibly richer and more vital culture. Even if we Germans were in fact nothing but successors we could not be anything greater or prouder than successors if we had appropriated such a culture and were the heirs and successors of that. What I mean by this and it is all I mean is that the thought of being epigones, which can often be a painful thought, is also capable of evoking great effects and grand hopes for the future in both an individual and in a nation, provided we regard ourselves as the heirs and successors of the astonishing powers of antiquity and see in this our honour and our spur. What I do not mean, therefore, is that we 1 03 should live as pale and stunted late descendants " of strong races coldly prolonging their life as antiquarians and gravediggers. Late descendants of that sort do indeed live an ironic existence: annihilation follows at the heels of the limping gait of their life; they shudder at it when they rejoice in the past, for they are embodied memory yet their remembrance is meaningless if they have no heirs. Thus they are seized by the troubled presentiment that their life is an injustice, since there will be no future life to justify it. But suppose we imagine these antiquarian latecomers suddenly exchanging this painfully ironic modesty for a state of shamelessness; suppose we imagine them announcing in shrill tones: the race is now at its zenith, for only now does it possess knowledge of itself, only now has it revealed itself to itself - we should then behold a spectacle through which, as in a parable, the enigmatic significance for German culture of a certain very celebrated philosophy would be unriddled. I believe there has been no dangerous vacillation or crisis of German culture this century that has not been rendered more dangerous by the enormous and still continuing influence of this philosophy, the Hegelian. The belief that one is a latecomer of the ages is, in any case, paralysing and depressing: but it must appear dreadful and devastating

when such a belief one day by a bold in version raises this latecomer to godhood as the true meaning and goal of all previous events, when his miserable condition is equated with a completion of world-history. Such a point of view has accosted the Germans to talk of a 'world-process' and to justify their own age as the necessary result of this world-process; such a point of view has set history, insofar as history is 'the concept that realizes itself', 'the dialectics of the spirit of the peoples' and the 'world tribunal', in place of the other spiritual powers, art and religion, as the sole sovereign power. History understood in this Hegelian fashion has been mockingly called God's sojourn on earth, though the god referred to has been created only by history. This god, however, became transparent and comprehensible to himself within the Hegelian craniums and has already ascended all the dialectically possible steps of his evolution up to this self-revelation: so that for Hegel the climax and terminus of the world-process coincided with his own existence in Berlin. Indeed, he ought to have said that everything that came after him was properly to be considered merely as a musical coda to the world-historical rondo or, even more properly, as superfluous. He did not say it: instead he implanted into the generation 1804 On the uses and disadvantages of history for life action thoroughly leavened by him that admiration for the 'power of history' which in practice transforms every moment into a naked admiration for success and leads to an idolatry of the factual: which idolatry is now generally described by the very mythological yet quite idiomatic expression 'to accommodate oneself to the facts'. But he who has once learned to bend his back and bow his head before the 'power of history' at last nods 'Yes' like a Chinese mechanical doll to every power, whether it be a government or public opinion or a numerical majority, and moves his limbs to the precise rhythm at which any 'power' whatever pulls the strings. If every success is a rational necessity, if every event is a victory of the logical or the 'idea' - then down on your knees quickly and do reverence to the whole stepladder of 'success'! What, are there no longer any living mythologies? What, the religions are dying out? Just behold the religion of the power of history, regard the priests of the mythology of the idea and their battered knees! Is it too much to say that all the virtues now attend on this new faith? Or is 'it not selflessness when the historical man lets himself be emptied until he is no more than an objective sheet of plate glass? Is it not magnanimity when, by worshipping in every force the force itself, one renounces all force of one's own in Heaven and upon earth? Is it not justice always to hold the scales of the powers in one's hands and to watch carefully to see which tends to be the stronger and heavier? And what a school of decorum is such a way of contemplating history! To take everything objectively, to grow angry at nothing, to love nothing, to understand everything, how soft and pliable that makes one; and even if someone raised in this school should for once get publicly angry, that is still cause for rejoicing, for one realizes it is intended

only for artistic effect, it is *ira* and *studium* and yet altogether *sine ira et studio*.'; How obsolete and old-fashioned my objections to this complex of mythology and virtue are! But I must out with them, even though they excite laughter. I would say therefore: history always inculcates: 'there was once', morality: 'you ought not to' or 'you ought not to have'. Thus history amounts to a compendium of factual immorality. How far astray he would go who regarded history as being at the same time the judge of this factual immorality! Morality is offended, for example, by the fact that a Raphael had to die at thirty-six: such a being ought not to die. If, in the face of this, you wanted to come to "Tacitus described his own manner of writing history as '*sine ira et studio*' ('with out anger and without partisan zeal'). *Studium* means 'course of study'. 105 the aid of history as apologists of the factual, you would say: he had expressed everything that was in him, had he lived longer he would have produced only a repetition of the beauty he had created already, and so forth. In that way you become Devil's advocates: you · make success, the factual, into your idol, while in reality the factual is always stupid and has at all times resembled a calf rather than a god. As apologists of history you have, moreover, ignorance as a prompter: for it is only because you do not know what such a *natura naturans** as Raphael is that you are not incensed to know that it once was but will never be again. We have recently been informed that, with his eighty-two years, Goethe outlived himself: yet I would gladly exchange a couple of Goethe's 'outlived' years for whole cartloads of fresh modern lifetimes, so as to participate in such conversations as Goethe conducted with Eckermann and thus be preserved from all and any up-to-date instruction from the legionaries of the moment. In relation to such dead men, how few of the living have a right to live at all! That the many are alive and those few live no longer is nothing but a brute truth, that is to say incorrigible stupidity, a blunt 'thus it is' in opposition to morality's 'it ought not to be thus'. Yes, in opposition to morality! For speak of any virtue you will, of justice, magnanimity, bravery, of the wisdom and sympathy of man - in every case it becomes a virtue through rising against that blind power of the factual and tyranny of the actual and by submitting to laws that are not the laws of the fluctuations of history. It always swims against the tide of history, whether by combating its passions as the most immediate stupid fact of its existence or by dedicating itself to truthfulness as falsehood spins its glittering web around it. If history in general were nothing more than 'the world-system of passion and error', mankind would have to read it as Goethe advised his readers to read Werther: as if it called to them 'be a man and do not follow after me!' Fortunately, however, it also preserves the memory of the great fighters against history, that is to say against the blind power of the actual, and puts itself in the pillory by exalting precisely these men as the real historical natures who bothered little with the 'thus it is' so as to follow 'thus it shall be' with a more cheerful pride. Not to

bear their race to the grave, but to found a new generation of this race - that is what impels them ceaselessly forward: and even if they themselves are late-born - there is a way of living which will *natura naturans: Spinoza's term for God under the aspect of creating nature, as opposed to created nature - as the cause of all things. 1 06 On the uses and disadvantages of history for life make them forget it - coming generations will know them only as first-born. Is our age perhaps such a first-born? - The vehemence of its historical sense is so great and is expressed in so universal and altogether unrestrained a manner, that future ages will in fact count it a first born at any rate in this respect - assuming, that is, that there will be any future ages in the cultural sense. But it is precisely this fact which evokes in us a grave doubt. Close beside the pride of modern man there stands his ironic view of himself, his awareness that he has to live in an historicizing, as it were a twilight mood, his fear that his youthful hopes and energy will not survive into the future. Here and there one goes further, into cynicism, and justifies the course of his tory, indeed the entire evolution of the world, in a manner especially adapted to the use of modern man, according to the cynical canon: as things are they had to be, as men now are they were bound to become, none may resist this inevitability. The pleasant feeling produced by this kind of cynicism is the refuge of him who cannot endure the ironical state; and the last decade has, moreover, made him a present of one of its fairest inventions, a full and rounded phrase to describe this cynicism: it calls his way of living in the fashion of the age and wholly without reflection 'the total surrender of the personality to the world-process'. The personality and the world-process! The world-process and the personality of the flea! If only one were not compelled everlastingly to hear the hyperbole of hyperboles, the word 'world, world, world' - when one ought more honestly to speak of 'man, man, man'! Heirs of the Greeks and Romans? of Christianity? To these cynics that seems nothing; but heirs of the world-process! Summit and target of the world-process! Meaning and solution of all the riddles of evolution come to light in modern man, the ripest fruit of the tree of knowledge! - that I call an ecstatic feeling of pride; it is by this sign that one can recognize the first-born of all ages, even though they may have also come last. Contemplation of history has never flown so far, not even in dreams; for now the history of mankind is only the continuation of the history of animals and plants; even in the profoundest depths of the sea the universal historian still finds traces of himself as living slime; gazing in amazement, as at a miracle, at the tremendous course mankind has already run, his gaze trembles at that even more astonishing miracle, modern man himself, who is capable of surveying this course. He stands high and proud upon the pyramid of the world process; as he lays the keystone of his knowledge at the top of it he seems to call out to nature all around him: 'We have reached the goal, we are the goal, we are nature perfected.' Overproud European of the nineteenth

century, you are raving! Your knowledge does not perfect nature, it only destroys your own nature. Compare for once the heights of your capacity for knowledge with the depths of your incapacity for action. It is true you climb upon the sunbeams of knowledge up to Heaven, but you also climb down to chaos. Your manner of moving, that of climbing upon knowledge, is your fatality; the ground sinks away from you into the unknown; there is no longer any support for your life, only spider's threads which every new grasp of knowledge tears apart. - But enough of this seriousness, since it is also possible to view the matter' more cheerfully. The madly thoughtless shattering and dismantling of all foundations, their dissolution into a continual evolving that flows ceaselessly away, the tireless unspinning and historicizing of all there has ever been by modern man, the great cross-spider at the node of the cosmic web - all this may concern and dismay moralists, artists, the pious, even statesmen; we shall for once let it cheer us by looking at it in the glittering magic mirror of a philosophical parodist in whose head the age has come to an ironical awareness of itself, and has done so with a clarity which (to speak Goethean) 'amounts to infamy'. Hegel once taught us: 'when the spirit changes direction, we philosophers too are there': our age changed direction, to self-irony, and behold! E. von Hartmann too was there and indited his celebrated philosophy of the unconscious, or - to speak more clearly - his philosophy of unconscious irony. We have seldom read a merrier invention or a more philosophical piece of roguery than this of Hartmann; whoever is not enlightened by it as to the nature of becoming, whoever is not inwardly cleared out and set in order, indeed, in regard to that matter, is truly ripe and ready for becoming a has-been. The beginning and goal of the world-process, from the first stab of consciousness to its being hurled back into nothingness, together with an exact description of the task of our generation within this world-process, all presented direct from that cleverly discovered well of inspiration, the unconscious, and gleaming with apocalyptic light, all so deceptively mimicking straight-faced earnestness as though it were a genuine serious philosophy and not only a joke philosophy such a production marks On the uses and disadvantages of history for life its creator as one of the first philosophical parodists of all time; let us therefore sacrifice on his altar, let us sacrifice to him, the discoverer of a true universal medicine, a lock of hair - to steal one of Schleiermacher's terms for expressing admiration. For what medicine could be more efficacious against excess of historical culture than Hartmann's parody of world-history? Expressed without the rhetoric, what Hartmann proclaims to us from the smokey tripod of unconscious irony amounts to this: he tells us it would be quite sufficient, for our time to be exactly as it is, to bring about, eventually, a condition in which people would find this existence intolerable: which we truly believe. This dreadful ossification of our age, this restless rattling of the bones - such as David Strauss has naively described to us as the fairest factuality - is

justified by Hartmann, not only from behind, *ex causis efficientibus*, but even from in front, *ex causa finali*; the rogue illumines our age with the light of the Last Day, and it turns out that our age is a very fine one, especially for him who wants to suffer as acutely as possible from the indigestibility of life and for whom therefore that Last Day cannot come quickly enough. It is true that Hartmann calls the time of life mankind is now approaching its 'years of manhood': but by this he means the happy condition in which all that is left is 'solid mediocrity', art is that which 'perhaps offers entertainment to the Berlin businessman of an evening', in which 'the age no longer requires genius, because it would mean casting pearls before swine or because the age has advanced beyond the stage appropriate to geniuses to a more important one' - to a stage of social evolution, that is to say, at which every worker, 'having a workday which leaves him adequate leisure for intellectual training, leads a comfortable existence'. Rogue of rogues, you give voice to the longings of contemporary mankind: but you likewise know the spectre that will stand at the end of these years of manhood as an outcome of that intellectual training in solid mediocrity - disgust. Things are already in a visibly sorry state, but they will get very much sorer, 'the Anti Christ is visibly extending his influence wider and wider' - but that is how it must be, that is what it must come to, for the road we have taken can lead only to disgust with all existence. 'Let us therefore press the world-process vigorously forward as workers in the vineyard of the Lord, for it is the process alone that can lead to redemption!' The vineyard of the Lord! The process! Redemption! Who cannot see and hear in this how historical culture, which knows only the word 'becoming', is here deliberately disguising itself as a parodistic deformity, how from behind a grotesque mask it utters the most mischievous nonsense about itself? For what does this last roguish summons to the workers in the vineyard really demand of them? What work are they to press vigorously forward? Or, to put the question differently: what does the historically cultivated man, the modern fanatic of the process swimming and drowning in the stream of becoming, have left to do if he is one day to harvest that disgust we have spoken of, the most exquisite grape of the vineyard? - He has to do nothing but go on living as he has lived hitherto, go on loving what he has loved hitherto, go on hating what he has hated hitherto, and go on reading the newspapers he has read hitherto; for him there is only one sin - to live differently from the way in which he has hitherto lived. How he has hitherto lived, however, is recorded for us in giant monumental characters on that celebrated page which has sent the whole contemporary cultured rabble into ecstasies because they see in them their own justification blazing forth in apocalyptic light. For what the unconscious parodist demands of each individual is 'the total surrender of the personality to the world process for the sake of its goal, world-redemption'; or even more clearly: 'affirmation of the will to live is proclaimed as for the present the only

right course; for only in a total surrender to life and its sorrows, and not in a cowardly renunciation and withdrawal, is any thing to be achieved for the world-process', 'the striving for denial of the individual will is as foolish and useless as, indeed even more foolish than, suicide'. 'The thinking reader will understand without further elucidation what shape a practical philosophy erected on these principles would assume, and that such a philosophy can embody, not a sundering from life, but only the fullest reconciliation with it.' The thoughtful reader will understand - as if anyone could mis understand Hartmann! And how unspeakably amusing it is that he should be misunderstood! Are the contemporary Germans a very refined people? A worthy Englishman finds them lacking in 'delicacy of perception', and ventures indeed to say: 'in the German mind there does seem to be something splay, something blunt-edged, unhandy and infelicitous' - would the great German parodist contradict this? It is true that, according to him, we are approaching 'that ideal condition in which the human race creates its history with full conscious awareness': but we are patently still far from that perhaps even more ideal condition in which mankind can read Hartmann's book with full conscious awareness. If they ever do so, no man will ever again utter the words 'world-process' 1 10 On the uses and disadvantages of history for life without smiling; for they will call to mind the time when Hartmann's parodistic gospel was listened to, absorbed, attacked, revered, propagated and canonized with all the simple honesty of the 'German mind', indeed with 'the wry earnestness of the owl', as Goethe puts it. But the world must get on, that ideal condition will not be created by dreaming, it must be fought and struggled for, and the path to redemption from that owlish earnestness lies only through cheerfulness. The time will come when one will prudently refrain from all constructions of the world-process or even of the history of man; a time when one will regard not the masses but individuals, who form a kind of bridge across the turbulent stream of becoming. These individuals do not carry forward any kind of process but live contemporaneously with one another; thanks to history, which permits such a collaboration, they live as that republic of genius of which Schopenhauer once spoke; one giant calls to another across the desert intervals of time and, undisturbed by the excited chattering dwarfs who creep about beneath them, the exalted spirit-dialogue goes on. It is the task of history to be the mediator between them and thus again and again to inspire and lend the strength for the production of the great man. No, the goal of humanity cannot lie in its end but only in its highest exemplars. Our comedian has, of course, a different point of view, and with that admirable dialectic which is as genuine as its admirers are admirable he tells us: 'The concept of evolution is not compatible with ascribing to the world-process an infinite duration in the past, since then every conceivable evolution must have already been run through, which is not the case (oh rogue!); so likewise we cannot concede to the process

an infinite duration in the future; both would annul the concept of evolution towards a goal (rogue again!) and would make the world-process resemble the Danaides' water-jugs. The complete victory of the logical over the illogical (oh rogue of rogues!) must, however, coincide with the temporal end of the world-process, the Last Day.' No, you alert and mocking spirit, as long as the illogical reigns as it does today, as long, for example, as one can speak of the 'world-process' as you speak of it and gain universal applause, the Last Day is still far off: for it is still too cheerful on this earth, many illusions still flourish, for example the illusion your contemporaries harbour about you, we are not yet ready to be hurled back into your nothingness: for we believe that it will be even merrier here once people have begun to understand you, you mis understood reader of the unconscious. If, however, disgust should nonetheless come with power, as you have prophesied to your readers, if your account of your present and future should turn out to be right and no one has despised them with such disgust as you have - then I am quite willing to vote with the majority, in the form proposed by you, that next Saturday night punctually at twelve o'clock the world shall perish; and our decree shall conclude: from tomorrow there shall be no more time and the newspapers shall appear no more. But perhaps our decree will have no effect: in that event, though, we shall at least have time to perform a fine experiment. We shall take a pair of scales and place Hartmann's unconscious on one of them and Hartmann's world-process on the other. There are people who believe they will weigh exactly the same: for in each of them there would lie an equally bad expression and an equally good joke. Once Hartmann's joke has been understood, Hartmann's expression 'world-process' will be of no use except as a joke. It has, in fact, for long been high time that the excesses of the historical sense, the immoderate revelling in the process at the expense of being and life, the senseless displacement of all perq:>ectives, were assaulted by all the militia satirical malice can summon; and it shall always be said in praise of the philosopher of the unconscious that he was the first to feel how ludicrous the idea of the 'world-process' is and to make others feel it even more strongly by the singular earnestness of his presentation of it. To what end the 'world' exists, to what end 'man kind' exists, ought not to concern us at all for the moment except as objects of humour: for the presumptuousness of the little human worm is the funniest thing at present on the world's stage; on the other hand, do ask yourself why you, the individual, exist, and if you can get no other answer try for once to justify the meaning of your existence as it were a posteriori by setting before yourself an aim, a goal, a 'to this end', an exalted and noble 'to this end'. Perish in pursuit of this and only this - I know of no better aim of life than that of perishing, animae magnae prodigus, * in pur suit of the great and the impossible. If, on the other hand, the doctrines of sovereign becoming, of the fluidity of all concepts, types and species, of the lack of any cardinal distinction between man

and animal - doctrines which I consider true but deadly - are thrust upon the people for another generation with the rage for instruction that has by now become normal, no one should be surprised if the people perishes of petty egoism, ossification 0: 'prodigal of a great soul' (Horace, Odes I.xII.38), here employed in the sense 'careless of life'. 1 1 2 On the uses and disadvantages. of history for life and greed, falls apart and ceases to be a people; in its place systems of individualist egoism, brotherhoods for the rapacious exploitation of the non-brothers, and similar creations of utilitarian vulgarity may perhaps appear in the arena of the future. To prepare the way for these creations all one has to do is to go on writing history from the standpoint of the masses and seeking to derive the laws which govern it from the needs of these masses, that is to say from the laws which move the lowest mud- and clay-strata of society. The masses seem to me to deserve notice in three respects only: first as faded copies of great men produced on poor paper with worn-out plates, then as a force of resistance to great men, finally as instruments in the hands of great men; for the rest, let the Devil and statistics take them! What, can statistics prove that there are laws in history? Laws? They certainly prove how vulgar and nauseatingly uniform the masses are: but are the effects of inertia, stupidity, mimicry, love and hunger to be called laws? Well, let us suppose they are: that, however, only goes to confirm the proposition that so far as there are laws in history the laws are worthless and the history is also worthless. But the kind of history at present universally prized is precisely the kind that takes the great mass-drives for the chief and weightiest facts of history and regards great men as being no more than their clearest expression, as it were bubbles visible on the surface of the flood. Greatness is, under this supposition, the product of the masses, which is to say order is the product of chaos; and it is only natural that in the end the hymn of praise is sung to the masses that produce it. That which has moved these masses for any length of time and has become what is called 'a power in history' is then accorded the name 'great'. But is that not a quite deliberate confusion of quantity with quality? When the rude masses have found some idea or other, a religious idea for instance, to their liking, strenuously defended it and dragged it along with them for centuries, then and only then is the inventor and founder of this idea to be called great. But why! The noblest and most exalted things make no effect whatever on the masses; the historical success of Christianity, its power in history, its tenacity and durability, happily proves nothing with respect to the greatness of its founder, for if it did it would be evidence against him: between him and that historical success there lies a very dark and earthy stratum of passion, error, thirst for power and honour, of the continuing strength of the imperium romanum, a stratum from which Christianity acquired the earthly residue and taste which made possible its continuance in this world and bestowed upon it as it were its tenability. Greatness ought not to depend on

success: Demosthenes possessed greatness though he had no success. The purest and truest adherents of Christianity have always hindered and called into question its worldly success and so-called 'power in history' rather than promoted them; for they were accustomed to place themselves outside the 'world' and had no regard for the 'process of the Christian idea'; for which reason they have as a rule remained wholly unknown and anonymous to history. Expressed in Christian terms: the Devil is the regent of this world and the lord of success and progress: in all the powers in history he is the actual power, and that is essentially how it will always remain - even though the fact may be painful to the ears of an age accustomed to the idolization of success and power in history. For it is an age that is practised in bestowing new names on things and has even rebaptized the Devil. It is indeed the hour of a great peril: mankind seems near to discovering that the egoism of individuals, groups or the masses has at all times been the lever of the movements of history; at the same time, however, this discovery has caused no perturbation of any kind, but on the contrary it has now been decreed: egoism shall be our god. In this new faith one is now setting to work with the clearest deliberation to erect the history of the future on the foundation of egoism: only it is to be a more prudent egoism than heretofore, an egoism which imposes certain restraints upon itself so as to ensure its endurance, an egoism which studies history precisely so as to become acquainted with that earlier imprudent egoism. In the course of this study it has been learned that a quite special role in the founding of the world-system of egoism devolves upon the state: it has to be the patron of all the prudent egoisms so as to protect them with its military and police forces against the terrifying outbreaks to which imprudent egoism is liable. It is to the same end that history - the evolutionary history of animal and man - is carefully inculcated into the dangerous, because imprudent, masses and working classes: one knows that a grain of historical culture is capable of breaking down dull and rude instincts and desires or of leading them into the path of a refined egoism. In summa: mankind is now, in the words of E. von Hartmann, 'with a thoughtful eye to the future taking into consideration a practical domestic establishment in the earthly homeland'. The same writer calls this period the 'manhood of mankind', and thereby mocks at that which is now called 'man' as though what is understood by this word were simply the sober self-seeker; just as he likewise prophesies an old-age to follow this period of manhood, though again he clearly means only to mock at our contemporary grey-beards: for he 1 1 4 On the uses and disadvantages of history for life speaks of the mature contemplativeness with which they 'review all the dissolute sufferings of their life's course and grasp how vain were the goals for which they had hitherto supposed they were striving'. No, a manhood of cunning and historically cultivated egoism is followed by an old-age which clings to life with repulsive greed and lack of dignity, and then by a final act in which the Last scene of all,

That ends this strange, eventful history, Is second childishness, and mere oblivion, Sans teeth, sans eyes, sans taste, sans every thing. * Whether our lives and culture are threatened by these dissolute, toothless and tasteless greybeards or by Hartmann's so-called 'men', let us in the face of both of them hold on with our teeth to the rights of our youth and never weary in our youth of defending the future against these iconoclasts who would wreck it. In this struggle, however, we shall have to discover a particularly unpleasant fact: that the excesses of the historical sense from which the present day suffers are deliberately furthered, encouraged and - employed. They are employed, however, against youth, so as to train them up to that mature manhood which is striven for everywhere; they are employed to combat the natural aversion of youth to such manly-unmanly egoism by transfiguring the latter in the magic light of science. We know, indeed, what history can do when it gains a certain ascendancy, we know it only too well: it can cut off the strongest instincts of youth, its fire, defiance, unselfishness and love, at the roots, damp down the heat of its sense of justice, suppress or regress its desire to mature slowly with the counter-desire to be ready, useful, fruitful as quickly as possible, cast morbid doubt on its honesty and boldness of feeling; indeed, it can even deprive youth of its fairest privilege, of its power to implant in itself the belief in a great idea and then let it grow to an even greater one. A certain excess of history can do all this, w.e have seen it do it: and it does it by continually shifting horizons and removing a protective atmosphere and thus preventing man from feeling and acting unhistorically. From an infinite horizon he then returns to himself, to the smallest egoistic enclosure, and there he must grow withered and dry: probably he attains to cleverness, never to wisdom. He 'listens to reason', calculates and accommodates himself to the facts, keeps calm, blinks and *From *As You Like It*, Act II Scene vii. 1 1 5 knows how to seek his own or his party's advantage in the advantage and disadvantage of others; he unlearns unnecessary modesty and thus step by step becomes the Hartmannesque 'man' and then 'greybeard'. But that is what he is supposed to become, precisely that is the sense of the cynical demand for the 'total surrender of the per sonality to the world-process' for the sake of its goal, world redemption, as that rogue, E. von Hartmann, assures us. Well, the will and goal of these Hartmannesque 'men' and 'greybeards' can hardly be precisely world-redemption: though the world would cer tainly be more redeemed if it were redeemed from these men and greybeards. For then there would come the empire of youth. . Mindful of this situation in which youth finds itself ! cry Land! Land! Enough and more than enough of the wild and erring voyage over strange dark seas! At last a coast appears in sight: we must land on it whatever it may be like, and the worst ofha-Mlours is better than to go reeling back into a hopeless infinity of scepticism. Let us only make land; later on we shall find good harbours right enough, and make the landfall easier for those who come after us.

This voyage was perilous and exciting. How far we still are from the quiet contemplativeness with which we first watched our ship put out. In pursuit of the perils of history we have found ourselves most acutely exposed to them; we ourselves bear visibly the traces of those sufferings which afflict contemporary mankind as a result of an excess of history, and I have no wish to conceal from myself that, in the immoderation of its criticism, in the immaturity of its humanity, in its frequent transitions from irony to cynicism, from pride to scepticism, the present treatise itself reveals its modern character, a character marked by weakness of personality. And yet I trust in the inspirational force which, in the absence of genius, powers my vessel, I trust that youth has led me aright when it now compels me to protest at the historical education of modern man and when I demand that man should above all learn to live and should employ history only in the service of the life he has learned to live. One has to be young to understand this protest; indeed, in view of the premature greybeardedness of our present-day youth one can hardly be young enough if one is to grasp what is here really being protested against. An example will help to make clear what I mean. It is hardly more than a century ago that there awoke in some young people in Germany a natural instinct for what we call poetry. Is it supposed that the generations before them and contemporary with them had failed even to mention that art, even though it was strange to them? The opposite is, of course, the case: they reflected, wrote and argued about 'poetry' with great vigour, producing words about words about words as they did so. This awakening to life of a word did not imply the death of those who awoke it; in a certain sense they are still living, for if, as Gibbon says, it requires only time, though a great deal of time, for a world to perish, so it requires only time, though in Germany, the 'land of gradualness', it requires very much more time, for a false idea to perish. Nonetheless, there are now perhaps a hundred more people than there were a hundred years ago who know what poetry is; perhaps a hundred years hence there will be a further hundred who by then will also have learned what culture is and that the Germans have up to now possessed no culture, however much they may talk and puff themselves up about it. To these people the Germans' universal contentment with their 'culture' will appear as incredible and silly as the once acclaimed classicism of Gottsched or Ramler's reputation as the German Pindar appear to us. They will perhaps think that this culture has been only a kind of knowledge about culture, and false and superficial knowledge at that. False and superficial, that is, because one endured the contradiction between life and knowledge and completely failed to see what characterized the culture of genuinely cultured peoples: that culture can grow and flourish only out of life; while among the Germans it was stuck on like a paper flower or poured over like icing-sugar, and was thus condemned to remain forever deceitful and unfruitful. The education of German youth, however,

proceeds from precisely this false and unfruitful conception of culture: its goal, viewed in its essence, is not at all the free cultivated man but the scholar, the man of science, and indeed the most speedily employable man of science, who stands aside from life so as to know it unobstructedly; its result, observed empirically, is the historical-aesthetic cultural philistine, the pre cocuous and up-to-the-minute babblers about state, church and art, the man who appreciates everything, the insatiable stomach which nonetheless does not know what honest hunger and thirst are. That an education with this goal and this result is an anti-natural one is apprehensible only to one who has not yet been fully processed by it; > it is apprehensible only to the instinct of youth, for youth still possesses that instinct of nature which remains intact until artificially and forcibly shattered by this education. He who wants, on the contrary, to shatter this education has to help youth to speak out, he has to light the path their unconscious resistance has hitherto taken with the radiance of concepts and transform it to a conscious and loudly vocal awareness. But how can he achieve so strange a goal? Above all by destroying a superstition: the belief in the necessity of this educational operation. The usual view is that our present highly disagreeable reality is the only one in any way possible. Examine with this in mind the literature of our higher school and educational system over the past decades: one will see with angry astonishment that, all the varying proposals and vehement contentions notwithstanding, the actual objective of education is everywhere thought of as being the same; that the outcome of education hitherto, the production of the 'educated man' as he is at present understood, is unhesitatingly assumed to be the necessary and rational foundation of all future education. The uniform canon is that the young man has to start with a knowledge of culture, not even with a knowledge of life and even less with life and experience itself. And this knowledge of culture is instilled into the youth in the form of his torical knowledge; that is to say, his head is crammed with a tremendous number of ideas derived from a highly indirect knowledge of past ages and peoples, not from direct observation of life. His desire to experience something himself and to feel evolving within him a coherent living complex of experiences of his own such a desire is confused and as it were made drunk by the illusory promise that it is possible to sum up in oneself the highest and most noteworthy experiences of former ages, and precisely the greatest of former ages, in a few years. It is exactly the same crazy method as that which leads our young painters into picture-galleries instead of into the workshop of a master and before all into the unique workshop of the unique master, nature. As though one could appropriate the arts and sciences of past times, the actual yield of their life's experience, by taking a fleeting stroll through the gallery of history! As though life itself were not a craft which must be learned from the ground up and practised remorselessly if it is not to eventuate in mere babblers and bunglers! - Plato considered it necessary that the

first generation of his new society (in the perfect state) should be educated with the aid of a mighty necessary lie: the children were to be taught to believe that they had all formerly dwelt asleep under the earth, where they had been kneaded into shape by nature's workman. Impossible to rebel 1 1 8 On the uses and disadvantages of history for life against a past of this sort! Impossible to go against the work of the gods! It was to count as an inviolable law of nature: he who is born a philosopher has gold in his body, he who is born a soldier has only silver, he who is born a worker has iron and bronze. As it is impossible to blend these metals together, Plato explained; so it should be impossible ever to mingle or confound the order of castes; belief in theaeterna veritas of this order is the foundation of the new education and therewith of the new state. - Now, this is how the modern German believes in theaeterna veritas of his system of education, of his kind of culture: and yet this belief would crumble away, as the Platonic state would have crumbled away, if the necessary lie were for once countered with a necessary truth: the truth that the German possesses no culture because his education provides no basis for one. He wants the flower without the root and the stem: consequently he wants it in vain. That is the simple truth, a coarse and unpleasant truth, truly a necessary truth. It is in this necessary truth, however, that our first generation must be educated; they will certainly suffer the most from it, for through it they will have to educate themselves, and in opposition to them selves moreover, to a new custom and nature and out of an old and first nature and custom: so that they could say to themselves in old Spanish: Defienda me Dios de my, God guard me from myself, that is to say from the nature already educated into me. It must taste this truth drop by drop, like a fierce and bitter medicine, and each one of this generation must overcome himself to the extent of being able to say of himself what he would find it easier to endure if it were said of an entire age: we are without culture, more, we are ruined for living, for right and simple seeing and hearing, for happily seizing what is nearest and most natural to us, and do not yet possess even the basis of a culture, because we are not even convinced we have genuine life in us.

Fragmented ' and in pieces, dissociated almost mechanically into an inner and an outer, sown with concepts as with dragon's teeth, bringing forth conceptual dragons, suffering from the malady of words and mistrusting any feeling of our own which has not yet been stamped with words: being such an unliving and yet uncannily active concept- and word-factory, perhaps I still have the right to say of myself cogito ergo sum, but not vivo, ergo cogito. Empty 'being' is granted me, but not full and green 'life'; the feeling that tells me I exist warrants to me only that I am a thinking creature, not that I am a living one, not that I am an animal but at most a cogito. Only give me life, 1 1 9 ;: : I I II, then I will create a culture for you out of it! - Thus cries each individual of this generation and all those individuals will recognize one another from this cry. Who is to give them

this life? No god and no man: only their own youth: unchain this and you will therewith have liberated life. For life was only lying hidden, in prison, it has not yet withered away and died ask yourselves if it has! But it is sick, this unchained life, and needs to be cured. It is sick with many illnesses and not only with the memory of its chains - what chiefly concerns us here is that it is suffering from the malady of history. Excess of history has attacked life's plastic powers, it no longer knows how to employ the past as a nourishing food. The evil is dreadful, and yet! if youth did not possess nature's clairvoyant gift no one would know it is an evil or that a paradise of health has been lost. This same youth, however, also divines with the curative instinct of this same nature how this paradise is to be regained; it knows the medicine and balsam against the malady of history, against excess of history: but what is this medicine called? Now, one must not be surprised to find that it is called by the names of poisons: the antidote to the historical is called -the unhistorical and the suprahistorical. And with these names we return to the beginning of our reflections and to its meditative calm. With the word 'the unhistorical' I designate the art and power of forgetting and of enclosing oneself within a bounded horizon; I call 'suprahistorical' the powers which lead the eye away from becoming towards that which bestows upon existence the character of the eternal and stable, towards art and religion. Science - for it is science which would here speak of poisons - sees in these two forces hostile forces: for science considers the only right and true way of regarding things, that is to say the only scientific way, as being that which sees everywhere things that have been, things historical, and nowhere things that are, things eternal; it likewise lives in a profound antagonism towards the eternalizing powers of art and religion, for it hates forgetting, which is the death of knowledge, and seeks to abolish all limitations of horizon and launch mankind upon an infinite and unbounded sea of light whose light is knowledge of all becoming. If only man could live in it! As cities collapse and grow desolate when there is an earthquake and man erects his house on volcanic land only in fear and trembling and only briefly, so life itself caves in and grows weak and fearful when the concept-quake caused by science

1 20 On the uses and disadvantages of history for life robs man of the foundation of all his rest and security, his belief in the enduring and eternal. Is life to dominate knowledge and science, or is knowledge to dominate life? Which of these two forces is the higher and more decisive? There can be no doubt: life is the higher, the dominating force, for knowledge which annihilated life would have annihilated itself with it. Knowledge presupposes life and thus has in the preservation of life the same interest as any creature has in its own continued existence. Thus science requires superintendence and supervision; a hygiene of life belongs close beside science and one of the clauses of this hygiene would read: the unhistorical and the suprahistorical are the natural antidotes to the stifling of life by the historical, by

the malady of history. It is probable that we who suffer from the malady of history will also have to suffer from the antidotes. But that we suffer from them is no evidence against the correctness of the chosen treatment. And here I recognize the mission of that youth I have spoken of, that first generation of fighters and dragon-slayers which will pre cede a happier and fairer culture and humanity without itself having more than a presentiment of this future happiness and beauty. This youth will suffer from both the sickness and the antidotes: and none theless it will believe itself entitled to boast of a more robust health and in general a more natural nature than its predecessors, the cultivated 'man' and 'greybeard' of the present. Its mission, however, is to undermine the concepts this present has of 'health' and 'culture' and to excite mockery and hatred against these hybrid monsters of concepts; and the sign that guarantees the superior robustness of its own health shall be that this youth can itself dis cover no concept or slogan in the contemporary currency of words and concepts to describe its own nature, but is only aware of the existence within it of an active power that fights, excludes and divides and of an ever more intense feeling of life. One may assen that this youth does not yet possess culture but for what youth would this constitute a reproach? One may point to its coarseness and immoderation - but it is not yet old or wise enough to moderate its claims; above all, it does not need hypocritically to defend a finished culture and it enjoys all the consolations and privileges that go with youth, especially the privilege of courageous, unreflecting honesty and the inspiring consolation of hope. Of these hopeful young people I know that they understand all these generalities from close personal experience and will translate them into a teaching intended for themselves; the others may for the 1 2 1 moment perceive only covered dishes that might well be empty: until one day they behold with surprise that the dishes are full and that attacks, demands, life-drives, passions have lain mingled and pressed together in these generalities and that they could not lie thus concealed for very long. Leaving these doubters to time, which brings all things to light, I turn in conclusion to that company of the hopeful to tell them in a parable of the course and progress of their cure, their delivery from the malady of history, and therewith their own history, up to the point at which they will be sufficiently healthy again to study history and, to the ends of life, to employ the past in its three senses, namely monumental or antiquarian or critical. At that point they will be more ignorant than the 'cultivated' people of this present, for they will have unlearned many things and even have lost all desire so much as to glance at that which these cultivated people want to know most of all; from the point of view of these cultivated people, their distinguishing marks are precisely their 'un culture', their indifference and reserve towards much that is of high repute, even towards much that is good. Hut at this end-point of their cure they will have become human again and have ceased to be merely aggregates of humanlike qualities - that is

something! That is some thing to hope for! Do your hearts not laugh when you hope, you hopeful young people? And how can we attain that goal? you will ask. At the beginning of a journey towards that goal, the god of Delphi cries to you his oracle: 'Know yourself.' It is a hard saying; for that god 'conceals nothing and says nothing, but only indicates, as Heraclitus has said. What does he indicate to you? There were centuries during which the Greeks found themselves faced by a danger similar to that which faces us: the danger of being overwhelmed by what was past and foreign, of perishing through 'history'. They never lived in proud inviolability: their 'culture' was, rather, for a long time a chaos of foreign, Semitic, Babylonian, Lydian, Egyptian forms and ideas, and their religion truly a battle of all the gods of the East: somewhat as 'German culture' and religion is now a struggling chaos of all the West and of all past ages. And yet, thanks to that Apollonian oracle, Hellenic culture was no mere aggregate. The Greeks gradually learned to organize the chaos by following the Delphic teaching and thinking back to themselves, that is, to their real needs, and letting their pseudo-needs die out. Thus they again took possession of themselves; they did not long remain the overburdened heirs and epigones of the entire Orient; after hard 1 22 On the uses and disadvantages of history Jor life struggle with themselves and through protracted application of that oracle, they even became the happiest enrichers and augmenters of the treasure they had inherited and the first-born and models of all future cultured nations. This is a parable for each one of us: he must organize the chaos within him by thinking back to his real needs. His honesty, the strength and truthfulness of his character, must at some time or other rebel against a state of things in which he only repeats what he has heard, learns what is already known, imitates what already exists; he will then begin to grasp that culture can be something other than a decoration of life, that is to say at bottom no more than dissimulation and disguise; for all adornment conceals that which is adorned. Thus the Greek conception of culture will be unveiled to him in antithesis to the Roman - the conception of culture as a new and improved physis, without inner and outer, without dissimulation and convention, culture as a unanimity of life, thought, appearance and will. Thus he will learn from his own experience that it was through the higher force of their moral nature that the Greeks achieved victory over all other cultures, and that every increase in truthfulness must also assist to promote true culture: even though this truthfulness may sometimes seriously damage precisely the kind of cultivatedness now held in esteem, even though it may even be able to procure the downfall of an entire merely decorative culture. 1 23 Schopenhauer as Educator I I I Iii t, ., ; A traveller who had seen many lands and peoples and several of the earth's continents was asked what quality in men he had discovered everywhere he had gone. He replied: 'They have a tendency to laziness.' To many it will seem that he ought rather to have said: 'They are all timid. They hide

themselves behind customs and opinions.' In his heart every man knows quite well that, being unique, he will be in the world only once and that no imaginable chance will for a second time gather together into a unity so strangely variegated an assortment as he is: he knows it but he hides it like a bad conscience why? From fear of his neighbour, who demands conventionality and cloaks himself with it. But what is it that constrains the individual to fear his neighbour, to think and act like a member of a herd, and to have no joy in himself? Modesty, perhaps, in a few rare cases. With the great majority it is indolence, inertia, in short that tendency to laziness of which the traveller spoke. He is right: men are even lazier than they are timid, and fear most of all the inconveniences with which unconditional honesty and nakedness would burden them. Artists alone hate this sluggish promenading in borrowed fashions and appropriated opinions and they reveal everyone's secret bad conscience, the law that every man is a unique miracle; they dare to show us man as he is, uniquely himself to every last movement of his muscles, more, that in being thus strictly consistent in uniqueness he is beautiful, and worth regarding, and in no way tedious. When the great thinker despises mankind, he despises its laziness: for it is on account of their laziness that men seem like factory products, things of no consequence and unworthy to be associated with or instructed. The man who does not wish to belong to the mass needs only to cease taking himself easily; let him follow his conscience, which calls to him: 'Be your self! All you are now doing, thinking, desiring, is not you yourself.' Every youthful soul hears this call day and night and trembles when he hears it; for the idea of life gives it a presentiment of the measure of happiness allotted it from all eternity - a happiness to which it can by no means attain so long as it lies fettered by the chains of fear and convention. And how dismal and senseless life can be without this liberation! There exists no more repulsive and desolate creature in the world than the man who has evaded his genius and who now looks furtively to left and right, behind him and all about him. In the end such a man becomes impossible to get hold of, since he is wholly exterior, without kernel, a tattered, painted bag of clothes, a decked-out ghost that cannot inspire even fear and certainly not pity. And if it is true to say of the lazy that they kill time, then it is greatly to be feared that an era which sees its salvation in public opinion, that is to say private laziness, is a time that really will be killed: I mean that it will be struck out of the history of the true liberation of life. How reluctant later generations will be to have any thing to do with the relics of an era ruled, not by living men, but by pseudo-men dominated by public opinion; for which reason our age may be to some distant posterity the darkest and least known, because least human, portion of human history. I go along the new streets of our cities and think how, of all these gruesome houses which the generation of public opinion has built for itself, not one will be standing in a hundred years' time, and how the opinions of these

house-builders will no doubt by then likewise have collapsed. On the other hand, how right it is for those who do not feel themselves to be citizens of this time to harbour great hopes; for if they were citizens of this time they too would be helping to kill their time and so perish with it -while their desire is rather to awaken their time to life and so live on themselves in this awakened life. But even if the future gave us no cause for hope the fact of our existing at all in this here-and-now must be the strongest incentive to us to live according to our own laws and standards: the inexplicable fact that we live precisely today, when we had all infinite time in which to come in to existence, that we possess only a shordived today in which to demonstrate why and to what end we came into existence now and at no other time. We are responsible to ourselves for our own existence; consequently we want to be the true helmsman of this existence and refuse to allow our existence to resemble a mind less act of chance. One has to take a somewhat bold and dangerous line with this existence: especially as, whatever happens, we are bound to lose it. Why go on clinging to this clod of earth, this way of life, why pay heed to what your neighbour says? It is so parochial to bind oneself to views which are no longer binding even a couple of hundred miles away. Orient and Occident are chalk-lines drawn before us to fool our timidity. I will make an attempt to attain freedom, the youthful soul says to itself; and is it to be hindered in this by the fact that two nations happen to hate and fight one Schopenhauer as educator another, or that two continents are separated by an ocean, or that all around it a religion is taught which did not yet exist a couple of thousand years ago. All that is not you, it says to itself. No one can construct for you the bridge upon which precisely you must cross the stream of life, no one but you yourself alone. There are, to be sure, countless paths and bridges and demi-gods which would bear you through this stream; but only at the cost of yourself: you would put yourself in pawn and lose yourself. There exists in the world a single path along which no one can go except you: whither does it lead? Do not ask, go along it. Who was it who said: 'a man never rises higher than when he does not know whither his path can still lead him'?* But how can we find ourselves again? How can man know himself? He is a thing dark and veiled; and if the hare has seven skins, man can slough off seventy times seven and still not be able to say: 'this is really you, this is no longer outer shell'. Moreover, it is a painful and dangerous undertaking thus to tunnel into oneself and to force one's way down into the shaft of one's being by the nearest path. A man who does it can easily so hurt himself that no physician can cure him. And, moreover again, what need should there be for it, since everything bears witness to what we are, our friendships and enmities, our glance and the clasp of our hand, our memory and that which we do not remember, our books and our handwriting. This, however, is the means by which an inquiry into the most important aspect can be initiated. Let the youthful soul look back on life with the

question: what have you truly loved up to now, what has drawn your soul aloft, what has mastered it and at the same time blessed it? Set up these revered objects before you and perhaps their nature and their sequence will give you a law, the fundamental law of your own true self. Compare these objects one with another, see how one completes, expands, surpasses, transfigures another, how they constitute a stepladder upon which you have clambered up to yourself as you are now; for your true nature lies, not concealed deep within you, but immeasurably high above you, or at least above that which you usually take yourself to be. Your true educators and formative teachers reveal to you that the true, original meaning and basic stuff of your nature is something completely incapable of being educated or formed and is in any case something difficult of access, bound and paralysed; your educators can be only your liberators. "Oliver Cromwell, as quoted in Ralph Waldo Emerson's essay 'Circles'. Nietzsche read Emerson's Essays in G. Fabricius's German translation (1858), a copy of which he owned and studied with great care. And that is the secret of all culture: it does not provide artificial limbs, wax noses or spectacles - that which can provide these things is, rather, only sham education. Culture is liberation, the removal of all the weeds, rubble and vermin that want to attack the tender buds of the plant, an outstreaming of light and warmth, the gentle rustling of nocturnal rain, it is imitation and worship of nature where nature is in her motherly and merciful mood, it is the perfecting of nature when it deflects her cruel and merciless assaults and turns them to good, and when it draws a veil over the expressions of nature's step motherly mood and her sad lack of understanding. Certainly there may be other means of finding oneself, of coming to oneself out of the bewilderment in which one usually wanders as in a dark cloud, but I know of none better than to think on one's true educators and cultivators. And so today I shall remember one of the teachers and taskmasters of whom I can boast, Arthur Schopenhauer - and later on I shall recall others. If I am to describe what an event my first glance at Schopenhauer's writings was for me, I must dwell for a moment on an idea which used to come to me in my youth more pressingly, and more frequently, than perhaps any other. When in those days I roved as I pleased through wishes of all kinds, I always believed that at some time fate would take from me the terrible effort and duty of educating myself: I believed that, when the time came, I would discover a philosopher to educate me, a true philosopher whom one could follow without any misgiving because one would have more faith in him than one had in oneself. Then I asked myself: what would be the principles by which he would educate you? - and I reflected on what he might say about the two educational maxims which are being hatched in our time. One of them demands that the educator should quickly recognize the real strength of his pupil and then direct all his efforts and energy and heat at them so as to help that one virtue to attain true maturity and fruitfulness. The other maxim, on the

contrary, requires that the educator should draw forth and nourish all the forces which exist in his pupil and bring them to a harmonious relationship with one another. But should he who has a decided inclination to be a goldsmith for that reason be forcibly compelled to study music? Is one to agree that Benvenuto Cellini's father was right continually to force him to play the 'dear little horn' - 'that accursed 130 Schopenhauer as educator piping', as his son called it? In the case of such strong and definite talents one would not agree: so could it perhaps be that that maxim advocating a harmonious development should be applied only to more mediocre natures in which, though there may reside a congeries of needs and inclinations, none of them amounts to very much taken individually? But where do we discover a harmonious whole at all, a simultaneous sounding of many voices in one nature, if not in such men as Cellini, men in whom everything, knowledge, desire, love, hate, strives towards a central point, a root force, and where a harmonious system is constructed through the compelling domination of this living centre? And so perhaps these two maxims are not opposites at all? Perhaps the one simply says that man should have a centre and the other that he should also have a periphery? That educating philosopher of whom I dreamed would, I came to think, not only discover the central force, he would -also know how to prevent its acting destructively on the other forces: his educational task would, it seemed to me, be to mould the whole man into a living solar and planetary system and to understand its higher laws of motion. In the meantime I still lacked this philosopher, and I tried this one and that one; I discovered how wretched we modern men appear when compared with the Greeks and Romans even merely in the matter of a serious understanding of the tasks of education. With the need for this in one's heart one can run through all Germany, especially its universities, and fail to find what one is seeking; for many far simpler and more basic desires are still unfulfilled there. Anyone who seriously wanted to train in Germany as an orator, for example, or intended to enter a school for writers, would find that school nowhere; it seems not to have been realized that speaking and writing are arts which cannot be acquired without the most careful instruction and arduous apprenticeship. Nothing, however, displays the arrogant self-satisfaction of our contemporaries more clearly or shamefully than their half niggardly, half thoughtless undemandingness in regard to teachers and educators. What will not suffice, even among our noblest and best-instructed families, under the name of family tutor; what a collection of antiques and eccentrics is designated a grammar school and not found wanting; what are we not content with for a university - what leaders, what institutions, in comparison with the difficulty of the task of educating a man to be a man! Even the much admired way in which our German men of learning set about their scientific pursuits reveals above all 1311 that they are thinking more of science than they are of mankind, that they have been

trained to sacrifice themselves to it like a legion of the lost, so as in turn to draw new generations on to the same sacrifice. If it is not directed and kept within bounds by a higher maxim of education, but on the contrary allowed to run wilder and wilder on the principle 'the more the better', traffic with science is certainly as harmful to men of learning as the economic principle of laissez-faire is to the morality of whole nations. Who is there that still remembers that the education of the scholar is an extremely difficult problem, if his humanity is not to be sacrificed in the process - and yet this difficulty is plainly obvious when one regards the numerous examples of those who through an unthinking and premature devotion to science have become crooked-backed and humped. But there is an even weightier witness to the absence of all higher education, weightier and more perilous and above all much more common. If it is at once obvious why an orator or a writer cannot now be educated in these arts - because there are no educators for them -; if it is almost as obvious why a scholar must now become distorted and contorted - because he is supposed to be educated by science, that is to say by an inhuman abstraction - then one finally asks oneself: where are we, scholars and unscholarly, high placed and low, to find the moral exemplars and models among our contemporaries, the visible epitome of morality for our time? What has become of any reflection on questions of morality - questions that have at all times engaged every more highly civilized society? There is no longer any model or any reflection of any kind; what we are in fact doing is consuming the moral capital we have inherited from our forefathers, which we are incapable of increasing but know only how to squander; in our society one either remains silent about such things or speaks of them in a way that reveals an utter lack of acquaintance with or experience of them and that can only excite revulsion. Thus it has come about that our schools and teachers simply abstain from an education in morality or make do with mere formalities: and virtue is a word that no longer means anything to our teachers or pupils, an old-fashioned word that makes one smile - and it is worse if one does not smile, for then one is being a hypocrite. The explanation of this spiritlessness and of why all moral energy is at such a low ebb is difficult and involved; but no one who considers the influence victorious Christianity had on the morality of our ancient world can overlook the reaction of declining Christianity upon our own time. Through the exaltedness of its ideal, Christianity as education excelled the moral systems of antiquity and the naturalism that resided in them to such a degree that this naturalism came to excite apathy and disgust; but later on, when these better and higher ideals, though now known, proved unattainable, it was no longer possible to return to what was good and high in antique virtue, however much one might want to. It is in this oscillation between Christianity and antiquity, between an imitated or hypocritical Christianity of morals and an equally despondent and timid revival of antiquity, that modern man lives, and does not

live very happily; the fear of what is natural he has inherited and the renewed attraction of this naturalness, the desire for a firm footing somewhere, the impotence of his knowledge that reels back and forth between the good and the better, all this engenders a restlessness, a disorder in the modern soul which condemns it to a joyless unfruitfulness. Never have moral educators been more needed, and never has it seemed less likely they would be found; in the times when physicians are required the most, in times of great plagues, they are also most in peril. For where are the physicians for modern mankind who themselves stand so firmly and soundly on their feet that they are able to support others and lead them by the hand? A certain gloominess and torpor lies upon even the finest personalities of our time, a feeling of ill-humour at the everlasting struggle between dissimulation and honesty which is being fought out within them, a lack of steady confidence in themselves - whereby they become quite incapable of being signposts and at the same time taskmasters for others. It was thus truly roving through wishes to imagine I might discover a true philosopher as, an educator who could raise me above my insufficiencies insofar as these originated in the age and teach me again to be simple and honest in thought and life, that is to say to be untimely, that word understood in the profoundest sense; for men have now become so complex and many-sided they are bound to become dishonest whenever they speak at all, make assertions and try to act in accordance with them. It was in this condition of need, distress and desire that I came to know Schopenhauer. I am one of those readers of Schopenhauer who when they have read one page of him know for certain they will go on to read all the pages and will pay heed to every word he ever said. I trusted him at once and my trust is the same now as it was nine years ago. Though this is a foolish and immodest way of putting it, I understand him as though it were for me he had written. Thus it is that I have never discovered any paradox in him, though here and there a little error; for what are paradoxes but assertions which carry no conviction because their author himself is not really convinced of them and makes them only so as to glitter and seduce and in general cut a figure. Schopenhauer never wants to cut a figure: for he writes for himself and no one wants to be deceived, least of all a philosopher who has made it a rule for himself: deceive no one, not even yourself! Not even with the pleasant sociable deception which almost every conversation entails and which writers imitate almost unconsciously; even less with the conscious deception of the orator and by the artificial means of rhetoric. Schopenhauer, on the contrary, speaks with himself: or, if one feels obliged to imagine an auditor, one should think of a son being instructed by his father. It is an honest, calm, good natured discourse before an auditor who listens to it with love. We are lacking such writers. The speaker's powerful sense of well... being embraces us immediately he begins to speak; we feel as we do on entering the high forest, we take a deep breath and

acquire that sense of wellbeing ourselves. We feel that here we shall always find a bracing air; here there is a certain inimitable unaffectedness and naturalness such as is possessed by men who are within themselves masters of their own house, and a very rich house at that: in contrast to those writers who surprise themselves most when they for once say something sensible and whose style therefore acquires some thing restless and unnatural. Schopenhauer's voice reminds us just as little of the scholar whose limbs are naturally stiff and whose chest is narrow and who therefore goes about with awkward embarrassment or a strutting gait; while on the other hand Schopenhauer's rough and somewhat bear-like soul teaches us not so much to feel the absence of the suppleness and courtly charm of good French writers as to disdain it, and no one will discover in him that imitated, as it were silver-plated pseudo-Frenchness in which German writers so much indulge. Schopenhauer's way of expressing himself reminds me here and there a little of Goethe, but otherwise he recalls no German model at all. For he understands how to express the profound with simplicity, the moving without rhetoric, the strictly scientific without pedantry: and from what German could he have learned this? He is also free of the over-subtle, over-supple and - if I may be allowed to say so - not very German style that characterizes Lessing: which is a great merit in him, for Lessing is the most seductive of all German writers of prose. And, to say without more ado the highest thing I can say in regard to his style, I cannot do better than Schopenhauer as educator quote a sentence of his own: 'a philosopher must be very honest not to call poetry or rhetoric to his aid'. That there is something called honesty and that it is even a virtue belongs, I know, in the age of public opinion to the private opinions that are forbidden; and thus I shall not be praising Schopenhauer but only characterizing him if I repeat: he is honest even as a writer; and so few writers are honest that one ought really to mistrust anyone who writes. I know of only one writer whom I would compare with Schopenhauer, indeed set above him, in respect of honesty: Montaigne. That such a man wrote has truly augmented the joy of living on this earth. Since getting to know this freest and mightiest of souls, I at least have come to feel what he felt about Plutarch: 'as soon as I glance at him I grow a leg or a wing.'^{*} If I were set the task, I could endeavour to make myself at home in the world with him. Schopenhauer has a second quality in common with Montaigne, as well as honesty: a cheerfulness that really cheers. *Aliis laetus, sibi sapiens.* For there are two very different kinds of cheerfulness. The true thinker always cheers and refreshes, whether he is being serious or humorous, expressing his human insight or his divine forbearance; without peevish gesturing, trembling hands, tearfilled eyes, but with certainty and simplicity, courage and strength, perhaps a little harshly and valiantly but in any case as a victor: and this it is to behold the victorious god with all the monsters he has combated that cheers one most profoundly. The cheerfulness one

sometimes encounters in mediocre writers and bluff and abrupt thinkers, on the other hand, makes us feel miserable when we read it: the effect produced upon me, for example, by David Strauss's cheerfulness. One feels downright ashamed to have such cheerful contemporaries, because they compromise our time and the people in it before posterity. This kind of cheerful thinker simply does not see the sufferings and the monsters he purports to see and combat; and his cheerfulness is vexing because he is deceiving us: he wants to make us believe that a viaory has been fought and won. For at bottom there is cheerfulness only where there is a victory; and this applies to the works of true thinkers just as much as it does to any work of art. Let its content be as dreadful and as serious as the problem of life itself: the work will produce a depressing and painful effect only if "" A misunderstanding of Montaigne's assertion: 'Je ne le puis si peu accointer que je n'en tire cuisse ou aile', which Florio translates as: 'He can no sooner come in my sight but I pull some leg or wing from him.' tAliis [actus, sibi sapiens: cheerful for others, wise for himself 1 35 the semi-thinker and semi-artist has exhaled over it the vapour of his inadequacy; while nothing better or happier can befall a man than to be in the proximity of one of those victors who, precisely because they have thought most deeply, must love what is most living and, as sages, incline in the end to the beautiful. They speak truly, they do not stammer, and do not chatter about what they have heard; they are active and live truly and not the uncanny masquerade men are accustomed to live: which is why in their proximity we for once feel human and natural and might exclaim with Goethe: 'How glorious and precious a living thing is! how well adapted to the conditions it lives in, how true, how full of being!'"* I am describing nothing but the first, as it were physiological, impression Schopenhauer produced upon me, that magical out pouring of the inner strength of one natural creature on to another that follows the first and most fleeting encounter; and when I subsequently analyse that impression I discover it to be compounded of three elements, the elements of his honesty, his cheerfulness and his steadfastness. He is honest because he . 6peaks and writes to himself and for himself, cheerful because he has conquered the hardest task by thinking, and steadfast because he has to be. His strength rises straight and calmly upwards like a flame when there is no wind, imperturbably, without restless wavering. He finds his way every time before we have so much as noticed that he has been seeking it; as though compelled by a law of gravity he runs on ahead, so firm and agile, so inevitably. And whoever has felt what it means to discover among our tragelaphine ment of today a whole, complete, self-moving, unconstrained and unhampered natural being will understand my joy and amazement when I discovered Schopenhauer: I sensed that in him I had discovered that educator and philosopher I had sought for so long. But I had discovered him only in the form of a book, and that was a great deficiency. So I strove all the harder to see through the book and to imagine the living man whose

great testament I had to read and who promised to make his heirs only those who would and could be more than merely his readers: namely his sons and pupils. I profit from a philosopher only insofar as he can be an example. That he is capable of drawing whole nations after him through this CI From the *Italianische Reise*, 9 October 1786. t'Tragelaphen-Menschheit'. A 'tragelaph' is a 'goat-stag', i.e. a 'horned beast'. 1 36 Schopenhauer as educator example is beyond doubt; the history of India, which is almost the history of Indian philosophy, proves it. But this example must be supplied by his outward life and not merely in his books - in the way, that is, in which the philosophers of Greece taught, through their bearing, what they wore and ate, and their morals, rather than by what they said, let alone by what they wrote. How completely this courageous visibility of the philosophical life is lacking in Germany! where the body is only just beginning to liberate itself long after the spirit seems to have been liberated; and yet it is only an illusion that a spirit can be free and independent if this achieved unlimitedness - which is at bottom creative self-limitation - is not demonstrated anew from morn till night through every glance and every gesture. Kant clung to his university, submitted himself to its regulations, retained the appearance of religious belief, endured to live among colleagues and students: so it is natural that his example has produced above all university professors and professorial philosophy. Schopenhauer had little patience with the scholarly castes, separated himself from them, strove to be independent of state and society - this is his example, the model he provides - to begin with the most superficial things. But many stages in the liberation of the philosophical life are still unknown among the Germans, though they will not always be able to remain unknown. Our artists are living more boldly and more honestly; and the mightiest example we have before us, that of Richard Wagner, shows how the genius must not fear to enter into the most hostile relationship with the existing forms and order if he wants to bring to light the higher order and truth that dwells within him. 'Truth', however, of which our professors speak so much, seems to be a more modest being from which no disorder and nothing extraordinary is to be feared: a self-contented and happy creature which is continually assuring all the powers that be that no one needs to be the least concerned on its account; for it is, after all, only 'pure science'. Thus what I was trying to say is that the philosopher in Germany has more and more to unlearn how to be 'pure science': and it is to precisely that end that Schopenhauer as a human being can serve as an example. It is, however, . nothing less than a miracle that he was able to become this human example: for he was pressed upon, from within and without, by the most tremendous dangers which would have crushed or shattered any weaker being. It seems to me there was a strong probability that Schopenhauer the human being would perish and at best leave behind 'pure science': but this too only at best; most probably neither human

being nor science would remain. An Englishman recently described the most general danger facing uncommon men who live in a society tied to convention: 'Such alien characters at first become submissive, then melancholic, then ill and finally they die. A Shelley would not have been able to live in England, and a race of Shelleys would have been impossible.'^{*} Our Holderlin and Kleist, and who knows who else besides, were ruined by their uncommonness and could not endure the climate of so called German culture; and only natures of iron, such as Beethoven, Goethe, Schopenhauer and Wagner are able to stand firm. But these too exhibit many of the effects of the wearying struggle they have had to engage in: they breathe heavily and their voice can easily become too loud. A practised diplomat who had seen and spoken with Goethe only now and then told his friends: 'Voilà un homme, qui a eu de grands chagrins!' - which Goethe translated as: 'There is another one who has had a hard time of it!' and added: 'If the traces of the sufferings we have endured are quoted from Goethe's Faust, Part I Scene 1.

1 44 Schopenhauer as educator accounting it will involuntarily be appraised too high. That is why, when he compares his own age with other ages, the philosopher must deliberately under-assess it and, by overcoming the present in himself, also overcome it in the picture he gives of life, that is to say render it unremarkable and as it were paint it over. This is a difficult, indeed hardly achievable task. The verdict of the philosophers of ancient Greece on the value of existence says so much more than a modern verdict does because they had life itself before and around them in luxuriant perfection and because, unlike us, their minds were not confused by the discord between the desire for freedom, beauty, abundance of life on the one hand and on the other the drive to truth, which asks only: what is existence worth as such? It will always be worth knowing what Empedocles, living as he did in the midst of the most vigorous and exuberant vitality of Greek culture, had to say about existence; his verdict possesses great weight, especially as it is not contradicted by a counter-verdict from any other great philosopher of the same great era. He speaks the most dearly, but essentially - that is if we listen carefully - they are all saying the same thing. A modern thinker will, to repeat, always suffer from an unfulfilled desire: he will want first to be shown life again, true, red-blooded, healthy life, so that he may then pronounce his judgment on it. To himself at least he will regard it as necessary that he should be a living human being if he is to believe he can be a just judge. This is the reason it is precisely the more modern philosophers who are among the mightiest promoters of life, of the will to live, and why from out of their own exhausted age they long for a culture, for a transfigured physis. But this longing also constitutes their danger: there is a struggle within them between the reformer of life and the philosopher, that is to say the judge of life. Wherever the victory may incline, it is a victory that will involve a loss. And how, then, did Schopenhauer elude this danger too? If it is commonly accepted that the

great man is the genuine child of his age, if he in any event suffers from the deficiencies of his age more acutely than do smaller men, then a struggle by such a great man against his age seems to be only a senseless and destructive attack on himself. But only seems so; for he is contending against those aspects of his age that prevent him from being great, which means, in his case, being free and entirely himself. From which it follows that his hostility is at bottom directed against that which, though he finds it in himself, is not truly himself: against the in decent compounding and confusing of things eternally incompatible, against the soldering of time-bound things on to his own untimeliness; and in the end the supposed child of his time proves to be only its stepchild. Thus Schopenhauer strove from his early youth against that false, idle and unworthy mother, his age, and by as it were expelling her from him, he healed and purified his being and rediscovered himself in the health and purity native to him. That is why Schopenhauer's writings can be used as a mirror of his age; and it is certainly not due to a fault in the mirror if everything time bound in his age appears as a disfiguring illness, as thin and pale, as enervated and hollow eyed, as the recognizable sufferings of his stepchildhood. The longing for a stronger nature, for a healthier and simpler humanity, was in his case a longing for himself; and when he had conquered his age in himself he beheld with astonished eyes the genius in himself. The secret of his being was now revealed to him, the intention of his stepmother age to conceal his genius from him was frustrated, the realm of transfigured physis was disclosed. When he now turned his fearless eye upon the question: 'What is life worth as such?' - it was no longer a confused and pallid age and its hypothetical, uncertain life upon which he had to pass judgment. He knew well that there is something higher and purer to be found and attained on this earth than the life of his own time, and that he who knows existence only in this ugly shape, and assesses it accordingly, does it a grave injustice. No, genius itself is now summoned, so that one may hear whether genius, the highest fruit of life, can perhaps justify life as such; the glorious, creative human being is now to answer the question: 'Do you affirm this existence in the depths of your heart? Is it sufficient for you? Would you be its advocate, its redeemer? For you have only to pronounce a single heartfelt Yes! and life, though it faces such heavy accusations, shall go free.' - What answer will he give? - The answer of Empedocles. This last remark may be allowed to remain incomprehensible for the moment: for I have now to deal with something extremely comprehensible, namely to explain how through Schopenhauer we are all able to educate ourselves against our age- because through him we possess the advantage of really knowing this age. Supposing, that is, that it is an advantage! In any event, it may no longer be possible a couple of centuries hence. I find it amusing to reflect on the idea that mankind may sometime soon grow tired of reading and that writers like Schopenhauer as educator will do so too, that the

scholar will one day direct in his last will and testament that his corpse shall be buried surrounded by his books and especially by his own writings. And if it is true that the forests are going to get thinner and thinner, may the time not come one day when the libraries should be used for timber, straw and brushwood? Since most books are born out of smoke and vapour of the brain, they ought to return to smoke and vapour. And if they have no fire of their own in them, fire should punish them for it. It is thus possible that a later century will regard our era as a *saeculum obscurum*, * because its productions have been used most abundantly for heating the stoves. How fortunate we are, therefore, that we are still able to know this age. For if concerning oneself with one's own age makes any sense at all, then it is a good thing to concern oneself with it as thoroughly as possible, so as to leave absolutely no doubt as to its nature: and it is precisely this that Schopenhauer enables us to do. Of course, it would be a hundred times better if this investigation should reveal that nothing so proud and full of hope as our own age has ever before existed. And there are indeed at this moment naive people in this and that corner of the earth, in Germany for instance, who are prepared to believe such a thing, and even go so far as to assert in all seriousness that the world was put to rights a couple of years ago and that those who persist in harbouring dark misgivings about the nature of existence are refuted by the 'facts'. The chief fact is that the founding of the new German Reich is a decisive and annihilating blow to all 'pessimistic' philosophizing that is supposed to be firm and certain. - Whoever is seeking to answer the question of what the philosopher as educator can mean in our time has to contest this view, which is very widespread and is propagated especially in our universities; he must declare: it is a downright scandal that such nauseating, idolatrous flattery can be rendered to our time by supposedly thinking and honourable men - a proof that one no longer has the slightest notion how different the seriousness of philosophy is from the seriousness of a newspaper. Such men have lost the last remnant not only of a philosophical but also of a religious mode of thinking, and in their place have acquired not even optimism but journalism, the spirit and spiritlessness of our day and our daily papers. Every philosophy which believes that the problem of existence is touched on, not to say solved, by a political ""
Saeculum obscurum: . dark age ti. e. with the founding of the Reich in 1 87 1 . 1 47 event is a joke- and pseudo-philosophy. Many states have been founded since the world began; that is an old story. How should a political innovation suffice to turn men once and for all into contented inhabitants of the earth? But if anyone really does believe in this possibility he ought to come forward, for he truly deserves to become a professor of philosophy at a German university, like Harms in Berlin Jirgen Meyer in Bonn and Carriere in Munich. Here, however, we are experiencing the consequences of the doctrine, lately preached from all the rooftops, that the state is the highest goal of mankind and that a man has no

higher duty than to serve the state: in which doctrine I recognize a relapse not into paganism but into stupidity. It may be that a man who sees his highest duty in serving the state really knows no higher duties; but there are men and duties existing beyond this - and one of the duties that seems, at least to me, to be higher than serving the state demands that one destroys stupidity in every form, and therefore in this form too. That is why I am concerned here with a species of man whose teleology extends somewhat beyond the welfare of a state, with philosophers, and with these only in relation to a world which is again fairly independent of the welfare of a state, that of culture. Of the many rings which, interlocked together, make up the human community, some are of gold and others of pinchbeck. Now, how does the philosopher view the culture of our time? Very differently, to be sure, from how it is viewed by those professors of philosophy who are so well contented with their new state. When he thinks of the haste and hurry now universal, of the increasing . velocity of life, of the cessation of all contemplativeness and simplicity, he almost thinks that what he is seeing are the symptoms of a total extermination and uprooting of culture. The waters of religion are ebbing away and leaving behind swamps or stagnant pools; the nations are again drawing away from one another in the most hostile fashion and long to tear one another to pieces. The sciences, pursued without any restraint and in a spirit of the blindest laissez . faire, are shattering and dissolving all firmly held belief; the educated classes and states are being swept along by a hugely contemptible money economy. The world has never been more worldly, never poorer in love and goodness. The educated classes are no longer lighthouses or refuges in the midst of this turmoil of secularization; they themselves grow daily more restless, thoughtless and loveless. Everything, contemporary art and science included, serves the coming . barbarism. The cultured man has degenerated to the greatest enemy 1 48 Schopenhauer as educator of culture, for he wants lyingly to deny the existence of the universal sickness and thus obstructs the physicians. They become incensed, these poor wretches, whenever one speaks of their weakness and resists their pernicious lying spirit. They would dearly like to make us believe that of all the centuries theirs has borne the prize away, and they shake with artificial merriment. Their way of hypocritically simulating happiness sometimes has something touching about it, because their happiness is something so completely incomprehensible. One does not even feel like asking them what Tannhauser asked Biterolf: 'What then, poor man, have you enjoyed?''* For ah! we ourselves know better and know otherwise. A winter's day lies upon us, and we dwell in high mountains, dangerously and in poverty. Every joy is brief, and every ray of sunlight is pale that creeps down to us on our white mountain. Music sounds, an old man turns a barrel-organ, the dancers revolve - the wanderer is deeply moved when he sees it: all is so wild, so taciturn, so colourless, so hopeless, and now there sounds

within it a note of joy, of sheer, unreflecting joy! But already the mists of early evening are creeping in, the note dies away, the wanderer's step grates on the ground; for as far as he can still see, he sees nothing but the cruel and desolate face of nature. If it may be one-sided to emphasize only the weakness of the outlines and the dullness of the colours in the picture of modern life, the other side of the picture is in no way more gratifying but only more disturbing. There are certainly forces there, tremendous forces, but savage, primal and wholly merciless. One gazes upon them with a fearful expectation, as though gazing into the cauldron of a witch's kitchen: at any moment sparks and flashes may herald dreadful apparitions. For a century we have been preparing for absolutely fundamental convulsions; and if there have recently been attempts to oppose this deepest of modern inclinations, to collapse or to explode, with the constitutive power of the so-called nation state, the latter too will for a long time serve only to augment the universal insecurity and atmosphere of menace. That individuals behave as though they knew nothing of all these anxieties does not mislead us: their restlessness reveals how well they know of them; they think with a precipitancy and with an exclusive preoccupation with themselves never before encountered in man, they build and plant for their own day alone, and the pursuit of happiness is never greater than when it *In Wagner's *Tannhäuser*, Act II. 1 49 has to be caught today or tomorrow: because perhaps by the day after tomorrow there will be no more hunting at all. We live in the age of atoms, of atomistic chaos. In the Middle Ages the hostile forces were held together by the church and, through the strong pressure it exerted, to some extent assimilated with one another. When the bond broke, the pressure relaxed, they rebelled against one another. The Reformation declared many things to be *adiaphora*, domains where religion was not to hold sway; this was the price at which it purchased its existence: just as Christianity had already had to pay a similar price in face of the much more religiously inclined world of antiquity. From there on the division spread wider and wider. Nowadays the crudest and most evil forces, the egoism of the money-makers and the military despots, hold sway over almost everything on earth. In the hands of these despots and money makers, the state certainly makes an attempt to organize everything anew out of itself and to bind and constrain all those mutually hostile forces: that is to say, it wants men to render it the same idolatry they formerly rendered the church. With what success? We have still to learn; we are, in any case, even now still in the ice-filled stream of the Middle Ages; it has thawed and is rushing on with devastating power. Ice-floe piles on ice-floe, all the banks have been inundated and are in danger of collapse. The revolution is absolutely unavoidable, and it will be the atomistic revolution: but what are the smallest indivisible basic constituents of human society? It is incontestable that the spirit of humanity is almost in greater danger during the approach of such eras than it is when they and the chaotic turmoil they

bring with them have actually arrived: the anxiety of waiting and the greedy exploitation of every minute brings forth all the cowardice and the self-seeking drives of the soul, while the actual emergency, and especially a great universal emergency, usually improves men and makes them more warm hearted. Who is there then, amid these dangers of our era, to guard and champion humanity, the inviolable sacred treasure gradually accumulated by the most various races? Who will set up the image of man when all men feel in themselves only the self-seeking worm and curish fear and have thus declined from that image to the level of the animals or even of automata? There are three images of man which our modern age has set up one after the other and which will no doubt long inspire mortals to a transfiguration of their own lives: they are the man of Rousseau, the man of Goethe and finally the man of Schopenhauer. Of these, the 1 50 Schopenhauer as educator first image possesses the greatest fire and is sure of producing the greatest popular effect; the second is intended only for the few, for contemplative natures in the grand style, and is misunderstood by the crowd. The third demands contemplation only by the most active men; only they can regard it without harm to themselves, for it debilitates the contemplative and frightens away the crowd. From the first there has proceeded a force which has promoted violent revolutions and continues to do so; for in every socialist earthquake and upheaval it has always been the man of Rousseau who, like Typhon under Etna, is the cause of the commotion. Oppressed and half crushed by arrogant upper classes and merciless wealth, ruined by priests and bad education and rendered contemptible to himself by ludicrous customs, man cries in his distress to 'holy nature' and suddenly feels that it is as distant from him as any Epicurean god. His prayers do not reach it, so deeply is he sunk in the chaos of unnaturalness. Scornfully he throws from him all the gaudy finery which only a short time before had seemed to him to constitute his essential humanity, his arts and sciences, the advantages of a refined life; he beats with his fists against the walls in whose shadow he has so degenerated, and demands light, sun, forest and mountain. And when he cries: 'Only nature is good, only the natural is human,' he despises himself and longs to go beyond himself: a mood in which the soul is ready for fearful decisions but which also calls up from its depths what is noblest and rarest in it. The man of Goethe is no such threatening power, indeed in a certain sense he is the corrective and sedative for precisely those dangerous excitations of which the man of Rousseau is the victim. In his youth Goethe was himself a devotee of the gospel of nature with his whole loving heart; his Faust was the highest and boldest reproduction of the man of Rousseau, at any rate so far as concerns his ravenous hunger for life, his discontent and longing, his traffic with the demons of the heart. But then see what eventuates from this great bank of clouds - certainly not lightning! And it is in precisely this that there is revealed the new image of man, Goethean man. One

would think that Faust would be led through a life everywhere afflicted and oppressed as an insatiable rebel and liberator, as the power that denies out of goodness, as the actual religious and demonic genius of subversion, in contrast to his altogether undemonic companion, though he cannot get rid of this companion and has to employ and at the same time despise his sceptical malice and denial - as is the tragic fate of every rebel and liberator. But one is mistaken if one expects anything of that kind; the man of Goethe here turns away from the man of Rousseau; for he hates all violence, all sudden transition but that means: all action; and thus the world-liberator becomes as it were only a world-traveller. All the realms of life and nature, all the past, all the arts, mythologies and sciences, see the insatiable spectator fly past them, the deepest desires are aroused and satisfied, even Helen does not detain him for very long - and then there must come the moment for which his mocking companion is lying in wait. At some suitable spot on earth his flight comes to an end, his wings fall off, Mephistopheles is at hand. When the German ceases to be Faust there is no greater danger than that he will become a philistine and go to the Devil - heavenly powers alone can save him from it. The man of Goethe is, as I have said, the contemplative man in the grand style, who can avoid languishing away on earth only by bringing together for his nourishment everything great and memorable that has ever existed or still exists and thus lives, even though his life may be a living from one desire to the next; he is not the man of action: on the contrary, if he does ever become a member of any part of the existing order established by the men of action one can be sure that no good will come of it - Goethe's own enthusiastic participation in the world of the theatre is a case in point - and, above all, that no 'order' will be overthrown. The Goethean man is a preservative and conciliatory power - but with the danger, already mentioned, that he may degenerate to a philistine, just as the man of Rousseau can easily become a Catilinian. If the former had a little more muscle-power and natural wildness, all his virtues would be greater. Goethe seems to have realized where the danger and weakness of his type of man lay, and he indicates it in the words of Jarno to Wilhelm Meister: 'You are vexed and bitter, that is very good; if only you would get really angry for once it would be even better.*' Thus, to speak frankly: it is necessary for us to get really angry for once in order that things shall get better. And to encourage us to that we have the Schopenhauerean image of man. The Schopenhauerean man voluntarily takes upon himself the suffering involved in being truthful, and this suffering serves to destroy his own wilfulness and to prepare that complete overturning and conversion of his being, which it is the real meaning of life to lead up to. This utterance of truth seems to other men a discharge of malice, for they regard the conservation of their inadequacies and humbug as a human duty and think that any - *In Wilhelm Meisters Lehrjahre (1795-6), Book 8. 152 Schopenhauer as educator one who disrupts their child's

play in this way must be wicked. They are tempted to cry to such a man what Faust said to Mephistopheles: 'So to the eternal active and creative power you oppose the cold hand of the Devil'; and he who would live according to Schopenhauer would probably seem more like a Mephistopheles than a Faust - seem, that is, to purblind modern eyes, which always see in denial the mark of evil. But there is a kind of denying and destroying that is the discharge of that mighty longing for sanctification and salvation and as the first philosophical teacher of which Schopenhauer came among us desanctified and truly secularized men. All that exists that can be denied deserves to be denied; and being truthful means: to believe in an existence that can in no way be denied and which is itself true and without falsehood. That is why the truthful man feels that the meaning of his activity is metaphysical, explicable through the laws of another and higher life, and in the profoundest sense affirmative: however much all that he does may appear to be destructive of the laws of this life and a crime against them. So it is that all his acts must become an uninterrupted suffering; but he knows what Meister Eckhart also knows: 'The beast that bears you fastest to perfection is suffering.' I would think that anyone who sets such a life's course before his soul must feel his heart open and a fierce desire arise within him to be such a Schopenhauerean man: that is to say, strangely composed about himself and his own welfare, in his knowledge full of blazing, consuming fire and far removed from the cold and contemptible neutrality of the so-called scientific man, exalted high above all sullen and ill-humoured reflection, always offering himself as the first sacrifice to perceived truth and permeated with the awareness of what sufferings must spring from his truthfulness. He will, to be sure, destroy his earthly happiness through his courage; he will have to be an enemy to those he loves and to the institutions which have produced him; he may not spare men or things, even though he suffers when they suffer; he will be misunderstood and for long thought an ally of powers he abhors; however much he may strive after justice he is bound, according to the human limitations of his insight, to be unjust: but he may console himself with the words once employed by his great teacher, Schopenhauer: 'A happy life is impossible: the highest that man can attain to is a heroic one. He leads it who, in whatever shape or form, struggles against great difficulties for something that is to the benefit. In Faust, Part I Scene 3. 153 of all and in the end is victorious, but who is ill-rewarded for it or not rewarded at all. Then, when he has done, he is turned to stone, like the prince in Gozzi's *Re coroo*, but stands in a noble posture and with generous gestures. He is remembered and is celebrated as a hero; his will, mortified a whole life long by effort and labour, ill success and the world's ingratitude, is extinguished in Nirvana.*' Such a heroic life, to be sure, together with the mortification accomplished in it, corresponds least of all to the paltry conception of those who make the most noise about it, celebrate festivals to the memory of great men, and

believe that great men are great in the same way as they are little, as it were through a gift and for their own satisfaction or by a mechanical operation and in blind obedience to this inner compulsion: so that he who has not received this gift, or does not feel this compulsion, has the same right to be little as the other has to be great. But being gifted or being compelled are contemptible words designed to enable one to ignore an inner admonition, slanders on him who has paid heed to this admonition, that is to say on the great man; he least of all lets himself be given gifts or be compelled he knows as well as any little man how to take life easily and how soft the bed is on which he could lie down if his attitude towards himself and his fellow men were that of the majority: for the objective of all human arrangements is through distracting one's thoughts to cease to be aware of life. Why does he desire the opposite to be aware precisely of life, that is to say to suffer from life - so strongly? Because he realizes that he is in danger of being cheated out of himself, and that a kind of agreement exists to kidnap him out of his own cave. Then he bestirs himself, pricks up his ears, and resolves: 'I will remain my own!' It is a dreadful resolve; only gradually does he grasp that fact. For now he will have to descend into the depths of existence with a string of curious questions on his lips: why do I live? what lesson have I to learn from life? how have I become what I am and why do I suffer from being what I am? He torments himself, and sees how no one else does as he does, but how the hands of his fellow men are, rather, passionately stretched out to the fantastic events portrayed in the theatre of politics, or how they strut about in a hundred masquerades, as youths, men, greybeards, fathers, citizens, priests, officials, merchants, mindful solely of their collective comedy and *From Schopenhauer's *Parerga und Paralipomena*: 'Nachträge zur Lehre von der Betätigung und Verneinung des Willens zum Leben'. 1 54 Schopenhauer as educator not at all of themselves. To the question: 'To what end do you live?' they would all quickly reply with pride: 'To become a good citizen, or scholar, or statesman' - and yet they are something that can never become something else, and why are they precisely this? And not, alas, something better? He who regards his life as no more than a point in the evolution of a race or of a state or of a science; and thus regards himself as belonging wholly to the history of becoming, has not understood the lesson set him by existence and will have to learn it over again. This eternal becoming is a lying puppet-play in beholding which man forgets himself, the actual distraction which disperses the individual to the four winds, the endless stupid game which the great child, time, plays before us and with us. That heroism of truthfulness consists in one day ceasing to be the toy it plays with. In becoming, everything is hollow, deceptive, shallow and worthy of our contempt; the enigma which man is to resolve he can resolve only in being, in being thus and not otherwise, in the imperishable. Now he starts to test how deeply he is entwined with becoming, how deeply with being - a tremendous task

rises before his soul: to destroy all that is becoming, to bring to light all that is false in things. He too wants to know everything, but not, in the way the Goethean man does, for the sake of a noble pliability, to preserve himself and to take delight in the multiplicity of things; he himself is his first sacrifice to himself. The heroic human being despises his happiness and his unhappiness, his virtues and vices, and in general the measuring of things by the standard of himself; he hopes for nothing more from himself and in all things he wants to see down to this depth of hopelessness. His strength lies in forgetting himself; and if he does think of himself he measures the distance between himself and his lofty goal and seems to see behind and beneath him only an insignificant heap of dross. The thinkers of old sought happiness and truth with all their might - and what has to be sought shall never be found, says nature's evil principle. But for him who seeks untruth in everything and voluntarily allies himself with unhappiness a miracle of disappointment of a different sort has perhaps been prepared: something inexpressible of which happiness and truth are only idolatrous counterfeits approaches him, the earth loses its gravity, the events and powers of the earth become dreamlike, transfiguration spreads itself about him as on summer evenings. To him who sees these things it is as though he were just beginning to awaken and what is playing about him is only the clouds of a vanishing dream. These too will at some time be wafted away: then it will be day. - 155 But I have undertaken to exhibit my experience of Schopenhauer as an educator, and it is thus not nearly sufficient for me to paint, and to paint imperfectly, that ideal man who, as his Platonic ideal as it were, holds sway in and around him. The hardest task still remains: to say how a new circle of duties may be derived from this ideal and how one can proceed towards so extravagant a goal through a practical activity - in short, to demonstrate that this ideal educates. One might otherwise think it nothing but an intoxicating vision granted us only for moments at a time, and then leaving us all the more painfully in the lurch and prey to an even deeper dissatisfaction. It is also indisputable that that is how we begin our association with this ideal - with a sudden contrast of light and darkness, intoxication and nausea - and that this is a repetition of an experience which is as old as ideals themselves. But we ought not to stand long in the doorway, we ought soon to get through the beginning. And so we have seriously to ask the definite question: is it possible to bring that incredibly lofty goal so close to us that it educates us while it draws us aloft? - that Goethe's mighty words may not be fulfilled in us: 'Man is born to a limited situation; he is able to understand simple, accessible, definite goals, and he accustoms himself to employing the means that happen to lie close at hand; but as soon as he oversteps his limits he knows neither what he wants nor what he ought to do, and it is all one whether he is distracted by the multiplicity of the things he encounters or whether his head is turned by their loftiness and dignity. It is always a misfortune

when he is induced to strive after something which he cannot proceed towards through self-initiated and regulated activity. '* The Schopenhauerian man appears to be singularly open to this objection: his dignity and loftiness can only turn our heads and thereby exclude us from any participation in the world of action; coherent duties, the even flow of life are gone. One man perhaps at last accustoms himself to living discontentedly according to two different rules of conduct, that is to say in conflict with himself, uncertain of how to act and therefore daily more feeble and unfruitful: while another may even renounce all action on principle and almost cease to pay any attention to the actions of others. The dangers are always great when things are made too difficult for a man and when he is in-

From Wilhelm. Meisters Lehrjahre, Book 6, 'Confession of a Beautiful Soul'. 156 Schopenhauer as educator capable of fulfilling any duties at all; stronger natures can be destroyed by it, the weaker, more numerous natures decline into a reflective laziness and in the end forfeit through laziness even their ability to reflect. Now, in face of such objections I am willing to concede that in precisely this respect our Kork has hardly begun and that from my own experience I am sure of only one thing: that from that ideal image it is possible to fasten upon ourselves a chain of fulfillable duties, and that some of us already feel the weight of this chain. But before I can conscientiously reduce this new circle of duties to a formula I must offer the following preliminary observations. More profoundly feeling people have at all times felt sympathy for the animals because they suffer from life and yet do not possess the power to turn the thorn of suffering against itself and to understand their existence metaphysically; one is, indeed, profoundly indignant at the sight of senseless suffering. That is why there has arisen in more than one part of the earth the supposition that the bodies of animals contain the guilt-laden souls of men, so that this suffering which at first sight arouses indignation on account of its senselessness acquires meaning and significance as punishment and atonement before the seat of eternal justice. And it is, truly, a harsh punishment thus to live as an animal, beset by hunger and desire yet incapable of any kind of reflection on the nature of this life; and no harder fate can be thought of than that of the beast of prey pursued through the wilderness by the most gnawing torment" rarely satisfied and even then in such a way that satisfaction is purchased only with the pain of lacerating combat with other animals or through inordinate greed and nauseating satiety. To hang on to life madly and blindly, with no higher aim than to hang on to it; not to know that or why one is being so heavily punished but, with the stupidity of a fearful desire, to thirst after precisely this punishment as though after happiness - that is what it means to be an animal; and if all nature presses towards man, it thereby intimates that man is necessary for the redemption of nature from the curse of the life of the animal, and that in him existence at last holds up before itself a mirror in which life appears no longer senseless but in its metaphysical significance. Yet

let us reflect: where does the animal cease, where does man begin? - man, who is nature's sole concern! As long as anyone desires life as he desires happiness he has not yet raised his eyes above the horizon of the animal, for he only desires more consciously what the animal seeks through blind impulse. But that is 1 57 what we all do for the greater part of our lives: usually we fail to emerge out of animality, we ourselves are the animals whose suffering seems to be senseless. But there are moments when we realize this: then the clouds are rent asunder, and we see that, in common with all nature, we are pressing towards man as towards something that stands high above us. In this sudden illumination we gaze around us and behind us with a shudder: we behold the more subtle beasts of prey and there we are in the midst of them. The tremendous coming and going of men on the great wilderness of the earth. their founding of cities and states, their wars, their restless assembling and scattering again, their confused mingling, mutual imitation, mutual outwitting and down treading, their wailing in distress, their howls of joy in victory- all this is a continuation of animality: as though man was to be deliberately retro gressed and defrauded of his metaphysical disposition, indeed as though nature, after having desired and worked at man for so long, now drew back from him in fear and preferred to return to the unconsciousness of instinct. Nature needs knowledge and it is terrified of the knowledge it has need of; and so the flame flickers restlessly back and forth as though afraid of itself and seizes upon a thousand things before it seizes upon that on account of which nature needs knowledge at all. In individual moments we all know how the most elaborate arrangements of our life are made only so as to flee from the tasks we actually ought to be performing, how we would like to hide our head somewhere as though our hundred eyed conscience could not find us out there, how we hasten to give our heart to the state, to money-making, to sociability or science merely so as no longer to possess it ourselves, how we labour at our daily work more ardently and thoughtlessly than is necessary to sustain our life because to us it is even more necessary not to have leisure to stop and think. Haste is universal because everyone is in flight from himself; universal too is the shy concealment of this haste because everyone wants to seem content and would like to deceive more sharp-eyed observers as to the wretchedness he feels; and also universal is the need for new tinkling word-bells to hang upon life and so bestow upon it an air of noisy festivity. Everyone is familiar with the strange condition in which unpleasant memories suddenly assert themselves and we then make great efforts, through vehement noise and gestures, to banish them from our minds: but the noise and gestures which are going on everywhere reveal that we are all in such a condition all the time, that we live in fear of memory and of 1 58 Schopenhauer as educator turning inward. But what is it that assails us so frequently, what is the gnat that will not let us sleep? There are spirits all around us, every moment of our life wants to say

something to us, but we refuse to listen to these spirit-voices. We are afraid that when we are alone and quiet something will be whispered into our ear, and so we-hate quietness and deafen ourselves with sociability. Now and again, as already said, we realize all this, and are amazed at all this vertiginous fear and haste and at the whole dreamlike condition in which we live, which seems to have a horror of awakening and dreams the more vividly and restlessly the closer it is to this awakening. But we feel at the same time that we are too weak to endure those moments of profoundest contemplation for very long and that we are not the mankind towards which all nature presses for its redemption: it is already much that we should raise our head above the water at all, even if only a little, and observe what stream it is in which we are so deeply immersed. And even this momentary emerging and awakening is not achieved through our own power, we have to be lifted up - and who are they who lift us? They are those true men, those who are no longer animal, the philosophers, artists and saints; nature, which never makes a leap, has made its one leap in creating them, and a leap of joy moreover, for nature then feels that for the first time it has reached its goal - where it realizes it has to unlearn having goals and that it has played the game of life and becoming with too high stakes. This knowledge transfigures nature, and a gentle evening-weariness, that which men call 'beauty', reposes upon its face. That which it now utters with this transfigured countenance is the great enlightenment as to the character of existence; and the supreme wish that mortals can wish is lastingly and with open ears to participate in this enlightenment. If we think of how much Schopenhauer for instance must have heard during the course of his life, then we might well say to ourselves afterwards: 'Alas, your deaf ears, your dull head, your flickering understanding, your shrivelled heart, all that I call mine, how I despise you! Not to be able to fly, only to flutter! To see what is above you but not to be able to reach it! To know the way that leads to the immeasurable open prospect of the philosopher, and almost to set foot on it, but after a few steps to stagger back! And if that greatest of all wishes were fulfilled for only a day, how gladly one would exchange for it all the rest of life! To climb as high into the pure icy Alpine air as a philosopher ever climbed, up to where all the mist and obscurity cease and where the fundamental constitution of things speaks in a voice rough and 1 59 D .. 1'[rigid but ineluctably comprehensible! Merely to think of this makes the soul infinitely solitary; if its wish were fulfilled, however, if its glance once fell upon things straight and bright as a beam of light, if shame, fear and desire died away what word could then describe the condition it would be in, that new and enigmatic animation without agitation with which it would, like the soul of Schopenhauer, lie extended over the tremendous hieroglyphics of existence, over the petrified doctrine of becoming, not as the darkness of night but as the glowing light of dawn streaming out over all the world. And what a fate, on the other hand, to

sense sufficient of the certainty and happiness of the philosopher to be able to feel the whole uncertainty and unhappiness of the non-philosopher, of him who desires without hope! To know oneself a fruit on the tree which can never become ripe because one's too much in the shadow, and at the same time to see close at hand the sunshine that one lacks!' There is enough torment here to make a man who is mis-talented in such a way malicious and envious, if he is capable of malice and envy at all; probably, however, he will at last turn his soul in another direction so that it shall not consume itself in vain longing - and now he will discover a new circle of duties. Here I have arrived at an answer to the question whether it is possible to pursue the great ideal of the Schopenhauerian man by means of a practical activity. One thing above all is certain: these new duties are not the duties of a solitary; on the contrary, they set one in the midst of a mighty community held together, not by external forms and regulations, but by a fundamental idea. It is the fundamental idea of culture, insofar as it sets for each one of us but one task: to promote the production of the philosopher the artist and the saint within us and without us and thereby to work at the perfecting of nature. For, as nature needs the philosopher, so does it need the artist, for the achievement of a metaphysical goal, that of its own self-enlightenment, so that it may at last behold as a clear and finished picture that which it could see only obscurely in the agitation of its evolution for the end, that is to say, of self-knowledge. It was Goethe who declared, in an arrogant but profound assertion, that nature's experiments are of value only when the artist finally comes to comprehend its stammerings, goes out to meet it halfway, and gives expression to what all these experiments are really about. 'I have often said', he once exclaimed, 'and I shall often repeat, that the *causa finalis* of the activities of men and the world is dramatic poetry. For the stuff is of absolutely no other use.' And so nature at last needs the saint, in whom the ego is completely 1 60

Schopenhauer as educator melted away and whose life of suffering is no longer felt as his own life - or is hardly so felt - but as a profound feeling of oneness and identity with all living things: the saint in whom there appears that miracle of transformation which the game of becoming never hits upon, that final and supreme becoming-human after which all nature presses and urges for its redemption from itself. It is incontestable that we are all related and allied to the saint, just as we are related to the philosopher and artist; there are moments and as it were bright sparks of the fire of love in whose light we cease to understand the word 'I', there lies something beyond our being which at these moments moves across into it, and we are thus possessed of a heartfelt longing for bridges between here and there. It is true that, as we usually are, we can contribute nothing to the production of the man of redemption: that is why we hate ourselves as we usually are, and it is this hatred which is the root of that pessimism which Schopenhauer had again to teach our age, though it has existed

for as long as the longing for culture has existed. Its root, not its flower; its bottom floor, so to speak, not its roof; the commencement of its course, not its goal: for at some time or other we shall have to learn to hate something else, something more universal, and cease to hate our own individuality and its wretched limitations, changeableness and restlessness: it will be in that elevated condition in which we shall also love something else, something we are now unable to love. Only when, in our present or in some future incarnation, we ourselves have been taken into that exalted - order of philosophers, artists and saints, shall we also be given a new goal for our love and hate - in the meantime we have our task and our circle of duties, our hate and our love. For we know what culture is. Applied to the Schopenhauerean man, it demands that we prepare and promote his repeated production by getting to know what is inimical to it and removing it - in short, that we unwearyingly combat that which would deprive us of the supreme fulfilment of our existence by preventing us from becoming such Schopenhauerean men ourselves. - Sometimes it is harder to accede to a thing than it is to see its truth; and that is how most people may feel when they reflect on the proposition: 'Mankind must work continually at the production of individual great men that and nothing else is its task.' How much one would like to apply to society and its goals something that can be learned from observation of any species of the animal or plant world: that its only concern is the individual higher exemplar, the more uncommon, more powerful, more complex, more fruitful how much one would like to do this if inculcated fancies as to the goal of society did not offer such tough resistance! We ought really to have no difficulty in seeing that, when a species has arrived at its limits and is about to go over into a higher species, the goal of its evolution lies, not in the mass of its exemplars and their wellbeing, let alone in those exemplars who happen to come last in point of time, but rather in those apparently scattered and chance existences which favourable conditions have here and there produced; and it ought to be just as easy to understand the demand that, because it can arrive at a conscious awareness of its goal, mankind ought to seek out and create the favourable conditions under which those great redemptive men can come into existence. But everything resists this conclusion: here the ultimate goal is seen to lie in the happiness of all or of the greatest number, there in the development of great communities; and though one may be ready to sacrifice one's life to a state, for instance, it is another matter if one is asked to sacrifice it on behalf of another individual. It seems to be an absurd demand that one man should exist for the sake of another man; 'for the sake of all others, rather, or at least for as many as possible!' O worthy man! as though it were less absurd to let number decide when value and significance are at issue! For the question is this: how can your life, the individual life, receive the highest value, the deepest significance? How can it be least squandered? Certainly only by your living for the good of the

rarest and most valuable exemplars, and not for the good of the majority, that is to say those who, taken individually, are the least valuable exemplars. And the young person should be taught to regard himself as a failed work of nature but at the same time as a witness to the grandiose and marvellous intentions of this artist: nature has done badly, he should say to himself; but I will honour its great intentions by serving it so that one day it may do better. By coming to this resolve he places himself within the circle of culture; for culture is the child of each individual's self-knowledge and dissatisfaction with himself. Anyone who believes in culture is thereby saying: 'I see above me something higher and more human than I am; let everyone help me to attain it, as I will help everyone . who knows and suffers as I do: so that at last the man may appear who feels himself perfect and boundless in knowledge and love, perception and power, and who in his completeness is at one with nature, the judge and evaluator of things.' It is hard to create in any one this condition of intrepid self-knowledge because it is impossible to teach love; for it is love alone that can bestow on the soul, not only a clear, discriminating and self-contemptuous view of itself, but also the desire to look beyond itself and to seek with all its might for a higher self as yet still concealed from it. Thus only he who has attached his heart to some great man receives thereby the first consecration to culture; the sign of that consecration is that one is ashamed of oneself without any accompanying feeling of distress, that one comes to hate one's own narrowness and shrivelled nature, that one has a feeling of sympathy for the genius who again and again drags himself up out of our dryness and apathy and the same feeling in anticipation for all those who are still struggling and evolving, with the profoundest conviction that almost everywhere we encounter nature pressing towards man and again and again failing to achieve him, yet everywhere succeeding in producing the most marvellous beginnings, individual traits and forms: so that the men we live among resemble a field over which is scattered the most precious fragments of sculpture where everything calls to us: come, assist, complete, bring to gether what belongs together, we have an immeasurable longing to become whole. This sum of inner states is, I said, the first consecration to culture; I now have to describe the effects of the second consecration, and I realize that here my task is more difficult. For now we have to make the transition from the inward event to an assessment of the outward event; the eye has to be directed outwards so as to rediscover in the great world of action that desire_ for culture it recognized in the experiences of the first stage just described; the individual has to employ his own wrestling and longing as the alphabet by means of which he can now read off the aspirations of mankind as a whole. But he may not halt even here; from this stage he has to climb up to a yet higher one; culture demands of him, not only inward experience, not only an assessment of the outward world that streams all around him, but finally and

above all . an act, that is to say a struggle on behalf of culture and hostility towards those influences, habits, laws, institutions in which he fails to recognize his goal: which is the production of the genius. He who is capable of raising himself to this second stage is snuck first of all by how extraordinarily simple and -rare knowledge of this goal is, how universal, by contrast, cultural endeavour is and what an unspeakable amount of energy is expended in its service. One asks oneself in amazement: is such knowledge perhaps completely unnecessary? Does nature attain its goal even when the majority misunderstand the objective of their endeavours? He who has accustomed himself to thinking highly of the unconscious purposefulness of nature will perhaps experience no difficulty in replying: 'Yes, that is how it is! Men may reflect and argue about their ultimate goal as much as they like, in the obscure impulse in the depths of them they are well aware of the rightful path.' To be able to contradict this, one must have experienced certain things; but he who really is convinced that the goal of culture is to promote the production of true human beings and nothing else, and then sees how even now, with all our expenditure and pomp of culture, the production of such human beings is hardly to be distinguished from cruelty to animals protracted into the human world, will think it very necessary finally to replace that 'obscure impulse' with a conscious willing. And he will think so especially for a second reason: that it shall cease to be possible for that drive which does not know its goal, that celebrated obscure impulse, to be employed for quite different objectives and directed on to paths which can never lead to the supreme goal, the production of the genius. For there exists a species of misemployed and appropriated culture you have only to look around you! And precisely those forces at present most actively engaged in promoting culture do so for reasons they reserve to themselves and not out of pure disinterestedness. Among these forces is, first of all, the greed of the money-makers, which requires the assistance of culture and by way of thanks assists culture in return, but at the same time, of course, would like to dictate its standards and objectives. It is from this quarter that there comes that favourite proposition and chain of conclusions which goes something like this: as much knowledge and education as possible, therefore as much demand as possible, therefore as much production as possible, therefore as much happiness and profit as possible- that is the seductive formula. Education would be defined by its adherents as the insight by means of which, through demand and its satisfaction, one becomes time-bound through and through but at the same time best acquires all the ways and means of making money as easily as possible. The goal would then be to create as many current human beings as possible, in the sense in which one speaks of a coin as being current; and, according to this conception, 164 Schopenhauer as educator the more of these current human beings it possesses the happier a nation will be. Thus the sole intention behind our modern educational institutions should be to

assist everyone to become current to the extent that lies in his nature, to educate everyone in such a way that they can employ the degree of knowledge and learning of which they are capable for the accumulation of the greatest possible amount of happiness and profit. What is demanded here is that the individual must be able, with the aid of this general education, exactly to assess himself with regard to what he has a right to demand of life; and it is asserted, finally, that there exists a natural and necessary connection between 'intelligence and property', between 'wealth and culture', more, that this connection is a moral necessity. Here there is a hatred of any kind of education that makes one a solitary, that proposes goals that transcend money and money-making, that takes a long time; such more serious forms of education are usually disparaged as 'refined egoism' and as 'immoral cultural Epicureanism'. Precisely the opposite of this is, of course, held in esteem by the morality that here counts as valid: namely, a speedy education so that one may quickly become a money-earning being, yet at the same time an education sufficiently thorough to enable one to earn a very great deal of money. A man is allowed only as much culture as it is in the interest of general money-making and world commerce he should possess, but this amount is likewise demanded of him. In short: 'Man has a claim to earthly happiness and for that reason he needs education, but only for that reason!' Secondly, there is the greed of the state, which likewise desires the greatest possible dissemination and universalization of culture and has in its hands the most effective instruments for satisfying this desire. Presupposing it knows itself sufficiently strong to be able, not only to unchain energies, but at the right time also to yoke them, presupposing its foundations are sufficiently broad and secure to sustain the whole educational structure, then the dissemination of education among its citizens can only be to its advantage in its competition with other states. Whenever one now speaks of the 'cultural state', one sees it as facing the task of releasing the spiritual energies of a generation to the extent that will serve the interests of existing institutions: but only to this extent; as a forest river is partially diverted with dams and breakwaters so as to operate a mill with the diminished driving-power thus produced - while the river's full driving-power would rather endanger the mill than operate it. This releasing of energies is at the same time, and much more, an enchaining of them. One has only to recall what Christianity has gradually become through the greed of the state. Christianity is certainly one of the purest revelations of the impulse to culture and especially of the impulse to the ever-renewed production of the saint; but since it has been employed in a hundred ways to propel the mills of state power it has gradually become sick to the very marrow, hypocritical and untruthful, and degenerated into a contradiction of its original goal. Even the most recent event in its history, the German Reformation, would have been no more than a sudden and quickly extinguished flare-up if it had not stolen fresh fuel from the fires of

conflict between the states. Thirdly, culture is promoted by all those who are conscious of possessing an ugly or boring content and want to conceal the fact with so-called 'beautifufonn'. Under the presupposition that what is inside is usually judged by what is outside, the observer is to be constrained to a false assessment of the content through externalities, through words, gestures, decoration, display, ceremoniousness. It some times seems to me that modern men b.l)re one another to a bound less extent and that they finally feel the need to make themselves interesting with the aid of all the arts. They have themselves served up by their artists as sharp and pungent repasts; they soak them selves in all the spices of the Orient and the Occident, and to be sure! they now smell very interesting, smelling as they do of all the Orient and the Occident. Now they are suitably prepared for satisfying every taste; and everyone shall have something, whether his incli nation be for the fresh-smelling or foul-smelling, for the sublimated or for peasant coarseness, for the Greek or the Chinese, for tragedies or for dramatized lewdness. The most celebrated chefs for these modern men who want to be interesting and interested at any cost are, as is well known, to be found among the French, the worst among the Germans. At bottom this fact is more consoling to the latter than to the former, and let us not hold it against the French in the least if they mock at us precisely because we are uninteresting and lack elegance and if, when individual Germans desire to be suave and elegant, it reminds them of the Indian who wanted a ring through his nose and demanded to be tattoQed. - And here I shall make a digression. Since the late war with France there have been many changes in Germany and it is clear that the return to peace has also brought with it certain new demands in regard to German culture. The war was for many their first visit to the more elegant half of the world; how unprejudiced the victor now 1 66 Schwenhauer as educator appears when he does not disdain to acquire a little culture from the vanquished! Handicrafts especially are repeatedly invited to com pete with the more cultivated neighbour, the fitting-out of the Gennan house is to be made similar to that of the French, even the' Gennan language is, through the foundation of an academy after the French model, to acquire 'sound taste' and rid itself of the questionable influence supposedly exerted upon it by Goethe a view expressed quite recently by the Berlin academician Dubois-Reymond. Our theatres have for long been quietly and with due decorum aspiring towards the same goal, even the elegant Gennan scholar has already been invented: so that we can expect that everything that has up to now refused to conform to the law of elegance - German music, tragedy and philosophy - will henceforth be set aside as un-Gennan. - But truly, Gennan culture would not be worth lifting a finger for if the Gennan understood by the culture he still lacks and is to aspire to, nothing but arts and artifices for prettifying life, including all the ingenuities of the dancing-master and the wallpaper-hanger, ifin the matter of language too he was concerned only with

academically approved rules and a certain general polish. The late war and self comparison with the French seem, however, hardly to have evoked any higher pretensions than these; on the contrary, I am often assailed by the suspicion that the German now wants violently to cast off those ancient obligations which his wonderful talentedness and the profound seriousness of his nature imposed upon him. He prefers to play monkey-tricks and to learn the arts and manners that make life entertaining. But there can be no more grievous slander against the German spirit than to treat it as though it were wax to be moulded in any way one pleases and thus also into a semblance of elegance. And if it is unfortunately true that a good proportion of the German nation is only too willing to be-moulded and kneaded into shape in this fashion, then one has to reiterate until the words are heeded: it no longer dwells in you, that ancient German nature which, though hard, austere and full of resistance, is so as the most precious of materials, upon which only the greatest of sculptors are permitted to work because they alone are worthy of it. What you have in you, on the contrary, is soft, pulpy matter; make with it what you will, form it into elegant dolls and interesting idols - here too the words of Richard Wagner will hold true: 'The German is angular and clumsy when he affects polish and politeness; but he is sublime and superior to everyone when he catches fire.' And the elegant have every reason to beware of this German fire, or one day it may con- ---, I sume them together with all their dolls and idols of wax. - One could, to be sure, derive that inclination for 'beautiful form' now getting the upper hand in Germany from other and deeper sources: from the prevailing haste, from the breathless grasping at every moment, from the precipitation that plucks all things from the bough too soon, from the race and pursuit that nowadays carves furrows in men's faces and as it were covers all they do with tattoos. As though a potion that prevents them from catching their breath were working within them, they storm ahead with indecent anxiety as the harassed slaves of the moment, opinion and fashion: so that the lack of dignity and decorum is indeed all too painfully evident and a deceitful elegance required to mask the 'sickness of this undignified haste. For that is how the fashionable greed for beautiful form is connected with the ugly content of contemporary man: the former is intended to conceal, the latter to be concealed. To be cultivated means: to hide from oneself how wretched and base one is, how rapacious in going for what one wants, how insatiable in heaping it up, how shameless and selfish in enjoying it. When I have in the past pointed out to someone that a German culture does not exist, more than once I have received the reply: 'But that is quite natural, for hitherto the Germans have been too poor and modest. Just let our compatriots become rich and self-confident, and then they will possess a culture too!' Though belief may make blessed, this kind of belief has the opposite effect on me, because I feel that the German culture which is here believed to possess a future- a culture of wealth, polish and feigned

gentility - is the most hostile antithesis of the German culture in which I believe. Certainly, he who has to live among Germans suffers greatly from the notorious greyness of their life and thought, from their formlessness, their stupidity and dull-mindedness, their coarseness in more delicate affairs, even more from their envy and a certain secretiveness and uncleanness in their character; he is pained and offended by their rooted joy in what is false and ungentle, in bad imitations, in the translation of good foreign things into bad native ones: now, however, that one has in addition, and as the most painful experience of all, their feverish restlessness, their search for success and profit, their overestimation of the moment, one is limitlessly indignant to think that all these maladies and weaknesses are on principle never to be cured but only painted over - with a 'culture of interesting form'! And this in the case of a nation which produced Schopenhauer and Wagner! And ought to do so often again! Or are we desperately deceiving ourselves? Do 168 Schopenhauer as educator those named perhaps no longer offer any guarantee whatever that such energies as theirs still exist in the German mind and spirit? Are they themselves exceptions, as it were the last tendrils of qualities formerly regarded as German? I admit I am here nonplussed, and thus I return to the path of more general reflection from which my anxious doubts often seek to divert me. I have not yet numbered all those powers which, though they demand culture, do so without recognizing the goal of culture, the production of the genius; three have been named: the greed of the money-makers, the greed of the state, and the greed of all those who have reason to disguise themselves behind form. I name fourthly the greed of the sciences and the characteristic qualities of their servants, the men of learning. Science is related to wisdom as virtuousness is related to holiness; it is cold and dry, it has not love and knows nothing of a deep feeling of inadequacy and longing. It is as useful to itself as it is harmful to its servants, insofar as it transfers its own character to them and thereby ossifies their humanity. As long as what is meant by culture is essentially the promotion of science, culture will pass the great suffering human being by with pitiless coldness, because science sees everywhere only problems of knowledge and because within the world of the sciences suffering is really something improper and incomprehensible, thus at best only one more problem. But if one accustoms oneself to translating every experience into a dialectical question-and-answer game and into an affair purely of the head, it is astonishing in how short a time such an occupation will wither a man up, how soon he becomes almost nothing but bones. Everyone knows and perceives this fact: so how is it nonetheless possible for young men not to start back at the sight of such skeletons, but on the contrary again and again blindly to give themselves over to the sciences without restraint or selectivity? It can hardly originate in any supposed 'desire for truth': for how could there exist any desire at all for cold, pure, inconsequential knowledge! What it really is that

impels the servants of science is only too obvious to the unprejudiced eye: and it is very advisable to examine and dissect the men of learning themselves for once, since they for their part are quite accustomed to laying bold hands on everything in the world, even the most venerable things, and taking them to pieces. If I am to speak out, I would say this: the man of learning consists of a confused network of very various impulses and stimuli, he is an altogether impure metal. First of all there is a strong and ever more intense curiosity, the search for adventures in the domain of knowledge, the constant stimulation exercised by the new and rare in contrast to the old and tedious. Then there is a certain drive to dialectical investigation, the huntsman's joy in following the sly fox's path in the realm of thought, so that it is not really truth that is sought but the seeking itself, and the main pleasure consists in the cunning tracking, encircling, and correct killing. Now add to this the impulse to contradiction, the personality wanting to be aware of itself and to make itself felt in opposition to all others; the struggle becomes a pleasure and the goal is personal victory, the struggle for truth being only a pretext. Then, the man of learning is to a great extent also motivated to the discovery of certain 'truths', motivated that is by his subjection to certain ruling persons, castes, opinions, churches, governments: he feels it is to his advantage to bring 'truth' over to their side. The following qualities are also prominently displayed in the man of learning, less regularly than the previous ones yet frequently enough. Firstly, probity and a sense for simplicity, very worthy things provided they are something more than clumsiness and lack of practice in dissimulation, for which, after all, a certain amount of wit is needed. Indeed, wherever wit and dexterity are strikingly in evidence, one should be a little on one's guard and reserve one's judgment as to the uprightness of character of the person possessing them. On the other hand, this probity is for the most part of little worth and seldom fruitful even in the cause of science, since it is wholly tied to convention and usually tells the truth only in simple things or in adiaphora; for in these cases laziness finds it easier to tell the truth than to keep silent about it. And because everything new makes it necessary to relearn, this probity will always, in case of need, reverse the old opinion and reproach the innovator with a lack of *sensus recti*. * It certainly resisted the teachings of Copernicus because in this case it had appearance and convention on its side. The hatred of philosophy not at all uncommon among men of learning is above all hatred of the long chains of conclusions and the artificiality of the proofs. At bottom, indeed, every generation of men of learning has an unconscious canon of permitted sagacity; whatever goes beyond it is called into question and all but employed to cast suspicion on the probity of its propounder. Secondly, shortsightedness for things close up, combined with great myopia for distant things and for what is universal. His field of vision is usually very small and he has to hold his eyes close to the object. If the man of learning wants to go *sensus*

recti: sense of what is right 1 70 Schopenhauer as educator from one point he has just subjected to scrutiny to another, he has to move his whole seeing-apparatus to this new point. He dissects a picture into little patches, like one who employs opera-glasses to view the stage and then has a sight now of a head, now of a piece of clothing, but never of anything whole. He never gets to see- these patches joined together, his perception of how they are connected is only the result of a conclusion, and thus he has no very strong conception of anything universal. Because he is incapable of viewing a piece of writing as a whole, for example, he judges it by a few passages or sentences or errors; he would be tempted to assert that an oil-painting is a disorderly heap of blots. - Thirdly, the sobriety and conventionality of his nature in its likes and dislikes. This quality leads him to take an especial pleasure in history, insofar as he can trace the motives of men of the past in accordance with the motives he himself knows of. A mole-tunnel is the right place for a mole. He is secure against any artificial or extravagant hypotheses; if he sticks at it, he will dig out all the commonplace motives that inform the past, because he feels himself to be of the same commonplace species. For precisely that reason, of course, he is usually incapable of understanding or appreciating what is rare, great and uncommon, that is to say what is essential and vital, in the past. - Fourthly, poverty of feeling and aridity. It makes him capable even of vivisection. He has no inkling of the suffering which knowledge often brings with it, and therefore has no fear of venturing into regions where the hearts of others fail them. He is cold and may therefore easily seem cruel. He is also considered daring, but he is no more daring than the mule, which is immune from vertigo. - Fifthly, low self-esteem, amounting to modesty. Though confined to a wretched little corner, they feel no sense of being sacrificed or wasted, they often seem to realize in the depths of them that they are not flying but creeping creatures. There is even something touching about this quality. - Sixth, loyalty towards their teachers and leaders. They sincerely want to help them, and they are well aware that they can best help them through discovery of truth. For their feeling towards them is one of gratitude, for it is only through them that they have gained entry to the worthy halls of science, which they would never have been able to do on their own. He who nowadays knows how to open up a new field within which even the weakest heads can labour with some degree of success becomes famous in a very short time: so great is the crowd that at once presses in. Every one of these loyal and grateful people is at the same time a misfortune for the master, to be 1 7 1 --: sure, since they all imitate him and his defects then seem disproportionately great and exaggerated because they appear in such tiny individuals, while it is the opposite with his virtues, which are proportionately diminished when these same individuals display them. - Seventh, routine continuation along the path on to which the scholar has been pushed, a conception of truth determined by

unthinking subjection to an acquired habit. Such natures are collectors, explainers, compilers of indices and herbariums; they study and prowl around a single domain simply because it never occurs to them that other domains exist. Their industriousness possesses something of the tremendous stupidity of the force of gravity: which is why they often achieve a great deal. - Eighth, flight from boredom. While the genuine thinker longs for nothing more than he longs for leisure, the ordinary scholar flees from it because he does not know what to do with it. His consolation lies in books: that is to say, he listens to what someone else thinks, and in this way he lets himself be entertained throughout the long day. He chooses especially books which in some way or other excite his personal sympathies, which permit him, through the arousal of like or dislike, to feel some emotion: that is to say, books in which he himself, or his class, his political or aesthetic or even merely grammatical dogmas, are the subject of discussion; and if there is a field of study in which he specializes he never lacks means of entertainment or fly-swatters against boredom. Ninth, the motive of breadwinning, that is to say at bottom the celebrated 'hobnobbing of an empty stomach'. Truth is served when it is in a position directly to procure salaries and advancement, or at least to win the favour of those who have bread and honours to distribute. But it is only this truth which is served: which is why a frontier can be drawn between the profitable truths served by many and the unprofitable truths: only a very few those who do not act on the principle *ingenii largitor venter** are devotees of the latter. - Tenth, recognition by fellow scholars, fear of lacking their recognition; a rarer and higher motive than the previous one, yet still very common. All the members of the guild keep a very jealous watch on one another, so that the truth upon which so much - bread, office, honours - depends shall be baptized with the name of its real discoverer. One gives punctual recognition to the discoverer of a truth, so that one can demand it in return if one should happen to discover a truth oneself. Untruth, error, is resoundingly exploded, so that the number "*ingenii largitor venter*:" 'the stomach is the squanderer of talent', from the prologue to the Satires of Persius. 172 Schopenhauer as educator of fellow candidates shall not grow too big; yet now and then the actual truth is exploded too, so as to make room, at least for a time, for obstinate and impudent errors; since here as elsewhere there is no lack of 'moral idiocies', otherwise called roguish pranks. Eleventh, the scholar from vanity, a rarer variety. He wants if possible to have a domain all to himself and to that end selects strange and curious studies, especially if they necessitate an unusually high expenditure, travelling, excavations, numerous connections in various countries. He is usually content to be gazed at in astonishment as something strange and curious himself and has no thought of earning his bread by means of his scholarly studies. - Twelfth, the scholar for fun. The amusement consists in looking for tangles in the sciences and unravelling them, while at the

same time taking care not to lose the feeling of playing through trying too hard. This scholar, it goes without saying, never penetrates into the depths of a problem, yet he will often notice things that the professional, with his laborious poring over it, never does. - If, finally, I designate as the thirteenth motive for scholarship the impulse to justice, one could object that this noble impulse, which is indeed likely to be regarded as virtually a metaphysical one, is altogether too hard to distinguish from the other impulses and fundamentally vague and ungraspable to the human eye; which is why I append this last number with the pious hope that this impulse is more common and influential among scholars than it appears to be. For a spark from the fire of justice fallen into a scholar's soul suffices to enkindle and purify his life and strivings, so that he no longer knows any rest and is forever expelled from the lukewarm or frosty mood in which scholars usually accomplish their daily work. If one now imagines all these elements, or some of them, vigorously mingled and shaken together, one has the coming-into being of the servant of truth. It is very strange how here, for the benefit of an affair basically extra- and suprahuman, pure, inconsequential and thus impulseless knowledge, a host of little, very human impulses should be poured together to produce a chemical compound, and how the product, the man of learning, should appear so transfigured in the light of that supraterrrestrial, exalted and altogether pure affair that one quite forgets the mixing and mingling that was needed for his production. Yet there are times when one is obliged to think of and remember precisely this: those times when the scholar's significance for culture is in question. For he who knows how to must observe that the scholar is by nature 173 unfruitful- a consequence of how he comes into existence! - and that he harbours a certain natural hatred for the fruitful man; which is why geniuses and scholars have at all times been at odds with one another. For the latter want to kill, dissect and understand nature, while the former want to augment nature with new living nature; and so there exists a conflict of activities and intentions. Wholly fortunate ages did not need the scholar and did not know him, wholly morbid and listless ages have valued him as the highest and most venerable of men and accorded him the highest rank. How it stands with our own age in regard to health and sickness who is sufficient of a physician to know that! Certainly the scholar is in very many ways still too highly valued, which has a harmful effect especially in all that concerns the evolving genius. The scholar has no heart for the latter's distress; he speaks past him in a sharp, cold voice, and all too soon he shrugs his shoulders as though over some thing queer and strange for which he has neither time nor inclination. Knowledge of the goal of culture cannot be found in him either. - But what have we gained at all from these reflections? The knowledge that where today culture seems to be most vigorously pursued nothing is known of this goal. However loudly the state may proclaim its service to culture, it furthers culture in order to further itself and

cannot conceive of a goal higher than its own welfare and continued existence. What the money-makers really want when they ceaselessly demand instruction and education is in the last resort precisely money. When those who require form ascribe to themselves the actual labour on behalf of culture and opine, for instance, that all art belongs to them and must stand in the service of their requirements, what is quite clear is that by affirming culture they are merely affirming themselves: that they too are therefore still involved in a misunderstanding. Enough has been said of the scholarly man of learning. And so we see that, however zealous all four powers . together may be in promoting their own interests with the aid of cul..l ture, they are dull and without inspiration when these interests are not involved. And that is why the conditions for the production of the genius have not improved in modern times, and why antipathy for original men has increased to such an extent that Socrates could not have lived among us and would in any event not have attained seventy. N ow I recall the theme I developed in the third section: that our whole modern world has so little the appearance of permanence and 1 74 Schopenhauer as educator solidity that one cannot prophesy an eternity even for its conception of culture. One has even to consider it probable that the next thou sand years will hit on a couple of new ideas which might make the hair of our contemporaries stand on end. The belief in a metaphysical significance of culture would in the end not be as alarming as all that: but perhaps some of the inferences one might draw from it in re spect of education and schooling might be. It demands, to be sure, a quite exceptional reflective capacity to be able to see beyond the educational institutions of the present to those altogether strange and different institutions which may perhaps be required only two or three generations hence. For while the efforts of our present-day higher educators serve to produce either the scholar or the civil servant or the money-maker or the cultural philistine or, finally and more usually, a compound of them all, those institutions still to be invented would have a more difficult task - though not one more difficult as such, since it would be in any event a more natural and to that extent also easier task; and can any thing be more difficult than, for example, to train a young man to be a scholar, a thing contrary to nature by the methods at present employed? The difficulty, however, lies for mankind in relearning and envisaging a new goal; and it will cost an unspeakable amount of effort to exchange the fundamental idea behind our present system of education, which has its roots in the Middle Ages and the ideal of which is actually the production of the medieval scholar, for a new fundamental idea. It is already time we took a clear view of these antitheses, for some generation has to commence the struggle if another is to win it. The individual who has grasped this new fun damental idea of culture already finds himself at the crossroads; ifhe takes one path he will be welcome to his own age, it will not fail to offer him laurels and rewards, powerful parties will bear him

along, behind him there will be as many likeminded men as there will be before him, and when the man in the front line gives the word of command it will re-echo through all the ranks. Here the first duty is 'to fight in rank and file', the second to treat as enemies all who refuse to fall in. The other path will offer him companions more seldom, it will be more difficult, more tortuous, steeper; those who have taken the first path will mock at him because his path is more wearisome and more often dangerous, and will try to entice him over to themselves. If the two paths happen to cross he will be mis handled, thrown aside or isolated by being cautiously walked around. Now, what does a cultural institution mean to these dis- 1 7 5 similar wanderers on differing paths? The tremendous crowd that presses towards its goal along the first path understands by it the rules and arrangements by means of which it itself is brought to order and marches forward and through which all the solitary and recalcitrant, all who are looking for higher and more remote goals, are excommunicated. For the smaller band on the other path an institution would have a quite different purpose to fulfil; it wants the protection of a firm organization so as to prevent itself from being washed away and dispersed by that tremendous crowd, and so that the individuals that comprise it shall not die from premature exhaustion or even become alienated from their great task. These individuals have to complete their work - that is the sense of their staying together; and all who participate in the institution have, through continual purification and mutual support, to help to prepare within themselves and around them for the birth of the genius and the ripening of his work. Not a few, including some from the ranks of the second- and third-rate talents, are destined for the task of rendering this assistance and only in subjection to such a destiny do they come to feel they have a duty and that their lives possess significance and a goal. Nowadays, however, it is precisely these talents who are diverted from their path and estranged from their instincts by the seductive voices of that modish 'culture'; the temptation is directed at their self-seeking impulses, at their weaknesses and vanities; it is to them precisely that the Zeitgeist whispers insinuatingly: 'Follow me and do not go there! For there you are only servants, assistants, instruments, outshone by higher natures, never happy in being what you really are, pulled along in bonds, laid in chains, as slaves, indeed as automata; here with me you shall, as masters, enjoy your free personality, your talents may glitter by their own light, you yourselves shall stand in the foremost rank, a tremendous following will throng around you, and the public acclamation will surely please you better than a noble assent bestowed from the cold ethereal heights of genius.' Even the best can succumb to such enticements: and what is decisive here is hardly the rarity and strength of the talent but rather the influence of a certain heroic basic disposition and the degree of profound kinship and involvement with the genius. For there do exist men who feel it as their own distress when they see the genius involved

in toilsome struggle, or in danger of destroying himself, or when the shortsighted greed of the state, the superficiality of the money-makers, the arid self-satisfaction of the scholars treat his work with indifference: and so I also hope there 1 76 Schopenhauer as educator are some who understand what I am trying to say with this exhibition of Schopenhauer's destiny and to what end, according to my notion, Schopenhauer as educator is actually to educate. - But leaving aside all thoughts of the distant future and a possible revolution in education: what would one have to desire and, if necessary, procure for an evolving philosopher at present to enable him to enjoy any leisure at all and, in the most favourable case, achieve the kind of existence demonstrated by Schopenhauer - not an easy one, to be sure, but certainly possible? What would have also to be devised to make it more probable that he would produce some effect on his contemporaries? And what obstacles would have to be removed so that above all his example should produce its full effect, so that the philosopher should again educate philosophers? Here our reflections turn to practicalities and hard realities. Nature wants always to be of universal utility, but it does not know how to find the best and most suitable means and instruments for this end: that is what it suffers from most, that is why nature is melancholy. That nature has wanted to make existence explicable and significant to man through the production of the philosopher and the artist is, given nature's own desire for redemption, certain; yet how uncertain, how dull and feeble is the effect it generally achieves with the philosophers and artists! How rarely does it achieve any effect at all! In the case of the philosopher especially it experiences great difficulty in employing him in a universally useful way; the means it employs seem to be only probing experiments and ideas it has chanced upon, so that countless times it fails to achieve its objective and most philosophers fail to become universally useful. Nature seems to be bent on squandering; but it is squandering, not through a wanton luxuriousness, but through inexperience; it can be assumed that if nature were human it would never cease to be annoyed at itself and its ineptitude. Nature propels the philosopher into mankind like an arrow; it takes no aim but hopes the arrow will stick somewhere. But countless times it misses and is depressed at the fact. Nature is just as extravagant in the domain of culture as it is in that of planting and sowing. It achieves its aims in a broad and ponderous manner: and in doing so it sacrifices much too much energy. The artist is related to the lovers of his art as a heavy cannon is to a flock of sparrows. It is an act of simplicity to start an avalanche 1 7 7 so as to sweep away a little snow, to strike a man dead so as to kill a fly on his nose. The artist and the philosopher are evidence against the purposiveness of nature as regards the means it employs, though they are also first-rate evidence as to the wisdom of its purpose. They strike home at only a few, while they ought to strike home at everybody and even these few are not struck with the force with which philosopher and artist launch

their shot. It is sad to have to arrive at an assessment of art as cause so different from our assessment of art as effect: how tremendous it is as cause, how paralysed and hollow as effect! The artist creates his work according to the will of nature for the good of other men: that is indisputable; nonetheless he knows that none of these other men will ever love and understand his work as he loves and understands it. Thus this greater degree of love and understanding is, given the ineptitude of nature, required for the production of a smaller degree; the greater and nobler is employed as a means of producing the lesser and ignoble. Nature is a bad economist: its expenditure is much larger than the income it procures; all its wealth notwithstanding, it is bound sooner or later to ruin itself. It would have ordered its affairs more rationally if its house-rule were: small expenses and hundredfold profit; if, for example, there were only a few artists, and these of weaker powers, but on the other hand numerous recipients of art of a stronger and more mighty species than the species of the artist: so that the effect of the work of art in relation to its cause would be a hundredfold magnification. Or ought one not at least to expect that cause and effect would be of equal force? but how little nature comes up to this expectation! It often seems as though an artist and especially a philosopher only chances to exist in his age, as a hermit or a wanderer who has lost his way and been left behind. Just think of the true greatness of Schopenhauer - and then of how absurdly small his effect has been! No honourable man of our age can fail to feel ashamed when he sees how Schopenhauer seems to belong to it only by accident and what forces and impotencies are to blame for the fact that his influence has been so minimal. First, for a long time, and to the everlasting shame of our era of literature, he had against him his lack of readers; then, when he acquired them, he had against him the inadequacy of his earliest advocates: even more, it seems to me, he had against him the obtuseness on the part of all modern men with regard to books, which they are altogether unwilling to take seriously; a new danger has gradually appeared in addition, deriving from the manifold attempts that have been made to adapt Schopenhauer as educator to this feeble age or even to employ him as an exotic and stimulating spice, as it were a kind of metaphysical pepper. So it is that, though he has gradually become famous and his name is, I think, already known to more people than Hegel's, he is nonetheless still a hermit and has still produced no effect! The honour of this achievement belongs least of all to his actual literary opponents and denigrators, firstly because there are few who can endure to read them, secondly because they lead those who can endure to do so directly to Schopenhauer; for who would let a donkey-driver dissuade him from mounting a handsome horse, no matter how extravagantly he extolled his donkey at the horse's expense? He who has recognized the unreason in the nature of this age, then, will have to think of means of rendering it a little assistance; his task, however, will be to make the free spirits and those who

suffer profoundly from our age acquainted with Schopenhauer, assemble them together and through them to engender a current capable of overcoming the ineptitude with which nature employs the philosopher. Such men will come to realize that the forces which blunt the effect of a great philosophy are the same as those which stand in the way of the production of a philosopher; which is why they are entitled to regard it as their goal to prepare the way for the reproduction of Schopenhauer, that is to say of the philosophical genius. That which opposed the effect and propagation of his teaching from the first, however, that which in the end wants to vitiate any rebirth of the philosopher with every means in its power, is, to speak bluntly, the perversity of contemporary human nature: which is why all great human beings have to squander an incredible amount of energy in the course of their development merely to fight their way through this perversity in themselves. The world they now enter is shrouded in humbug; it does not have to be religious dogma, it can also be such bogus concepts as 'progress', 'universal education', 'national', 'modern state', 'cultural struggle'; one can say, indeed, that all generalizing words now wear artificial and unnatural finery, so that a more enlightened posterity will reproach our age with being to an unheard-of degree distorted and degenerate, however much we may boast of our 'health'. The beauty of antique vessels, says Schopenhauer, arises from the fact that they express in so naive a way what they are intended to be and to perform; and the same applies to all the other articles of the ancients: on beholding them one feels that, if nature produced vases, amphorae, lamps, tables, chairs, helmets, shields, armour and so forth, this is how they would look. Conversely: whoever observes general modern attitudes to art, state, religion, education - not to speak, for good reasons, of our 'vessels' discovers in mankind a certain barbaric capriciousness and intemperance of expression, and the genius is hampered most of all in his development by the prevalence in his time of such strange concepts and fanciful requirements: these are the leaden pressures which, invisible and inexplicable, so often weigh down his hand when he sets it to the plough - so that, because even his supreme works have had to force their way up violently, they too to some extent bear the traces of this violence. If I now seek out the conditions with the assistance of which a born philosopher can in the most favourable case at least avoid being crushed by the perversity of our times just described, I notice some thing singular: they are in part precisely the conditions under which Schopenhauer himself on the whole grew up. There is no lack of contrary conditions, to be sure: the perversity of the age came fearfully close to him, for example, in the person of his vain and culturally pretentious mother. But the proud, free, republican character of his father as it were saved him from his mother and bestowed upon him the first thing a philosopher needs: inflexible and rugged manliness. This father of his was neither an official nor a scholar: he travelled a great deal with the boy in foreign countries - all of these

things so many encouragements for one who was to study not books but men, and revere not governments but truth. He learned in good time to be indifferent to national narrownesses or extremely critical of them; he lived in England, France and Italy as he did in his own country and felt not a little affinity with the spirit of Spain. On the whole he did not regard it as an honour to have been born among Germans; and I do not know that he would have felt differently under the new political dispensation. As is well known, he considered the purpose of the state to be to provide protection against forces from without, protection against forces from within, and protection against the protectors, and that if any purpose was invented for it other than the provision of protection its true purpose could easily be imperilled -: that is why, to the horror of all so-called liberals, he left his property to the survivors among the Prussian troops whose comrades had fallen fighting for the preservation of order in 1848. It will probably be increasingly the sign of spiritual superiority from now on if a man takes the state and his duties as educator towards it lightly; for he who has the *furor philosophicus* * within him will already no longer have time for the *furor politicus* and will wisely refrain from reading the newspapers every day, let alone working for a political party: though he will not hesitate for a moment to be at his place when his fatherland experiences a real emergency. Every state in which anyone other than the statesman has to concern himself with politics is ill organized and deserves to perish by all these politicians. Another great advantage Schopenhauer enjoyed was the fact that he was not brought up destined from the first to be a scholar, but actually worked for a time, if with reluctance, in a merchant's office and in any event breathed throughout his entire youth the freer air of a great mercantile house. A scholar can never become a philosopher; for even Kant was unable to do so but, the inborn pressure of his genius notwithstanding, remained to the end as it were in a chrysalis stage. He who thinks that in saying this I am doing Kant an injustice does not know what a philosopher is, namely not merely a great thinker but also a real human being; and when did a scholar ever become a real human being? He who lets concepts, opinions, past events, books, step between himself and things - he, that is to say, who is in the broadest sense born for history - will never have an immediate perception of things and will never be an immediately perceived thing himself; but both these conditions belong together in the philosopher, because most of the instruction he receives he has to acquire out of himself and because he serves himself as a reflection and brief abstract of the whole world. If a man perceives himself by means of the opinions of others, it is no wonder if he sees in himself nothing but the opinions of others! And that is how scholars are, live and see. Schopenhauer, on the other hand, had the indescribable good fortune to be able to see genius from close up not only in himself, but also outside himself in Goethe: through this twofold reflection he was aware of and wise to all scholarly

goals and cultures from the ground up. By virtue of this experience he knew what the strong and free human being for which every artistic culture longs must be like; given this insight, how could he have had much desire left to involve himself with so-called 'art' in the scholarly or hypocritical *furor philosophicus: philosophical passion t furor politicus: political passion 1 8 1 manner of modern man? For he had seen something higher: a dreadful scene in a supraterrrestrial court in which all life, even the highest and most perfect, had been weighed and found wanting: he had seen the saint as judge of existence. We cannot determine at all closely how early in his life Schopenhauer must have perceived this picture of life in all its details and as he sought to reproduce it in all his subsequent writings; we can · demonstrate that he saw this tremendous vision as a young man, and can well believe he had already seen it as a child. Everything he subsequently appropriated to himself from life and books, from the whole wealth of the sciences, was to him hardly more than colouring and means of expression; he employed even the Kantian philosophy above all as an extra ordinary rhetorical instrument through which he believed he could speak of that picture more clearly: just as he occasionally made use of Buddhist and Christian mythology to the same end. For him there was only one task and a hundred-thousand means of encompassing it: one meaning and countless hieroglyphics with which to express it. I Among the most glorious conditions of his existence was the fact that he was able, in accordance with his motto *vitam impendere vero*, * really to live for such a task and that he was oppressed by none of the petty necessities of life: - how generously he attributed this circum stance to the efforts of his father is well known; whereas in Germany the theoretical man usually pursues his scholarly destiny at the expense of the purity of his character, as a 'thinking ragamuffin', greedy for posts and honours, cautious and pliable, ingratiating towards those with influence and position. Of all the offence Schopenhauer has given to numerous scholars, nothing has offended them more than the unfortunate fact that he does not resemble them. These, then, are some of the conditions under which the philosophical genius can at any rate come into existence in our time despite the forces working against it: free manliness of character, early knowledge of mankind, no scholarly education, no narrow patriotism, no necessity for bread-winning, no ties with the state - in short, freedom and again freedom: that wonderful and perilous ele ment in which the Greek philosophers were able to grow up. "*vitam impendere vero*: devote one's life to the truth 1 82 Schopenhauer as educator Whoever wants to reproach him, as Niebuhr reproached Plato, with being a bad citizen, let him do so and be a good citizen himself: thus he will be in the right and so will Plato. Another will see this great freedom as a piece of presumption: he too is ,right, for he himself would do nothing with it and it would be very presumptuous in him to claim it for himself. That freedom is in fact a heavy debt which can be discharged only by means of

great deeds. In truth, every ordinary son of earth has the right to regard with resentment a man favoured in this way: only may some god guard him from being thus favoured himself, that is from becoming so fearfully indebted. For he would at once perish of his freedom and solitude, and become a fool, and a malicious fool at that, out of boredom. From what we have discussed perhaps some father or other may be able to learn something and apply it in some way to the private education of his son; though it is truly not to be expected that fathers will want only philosophers for sons. It is probable that fathers in every age have put up the most determined resistance to their sons' being philosophers, as though it were extremely perverse; as is well known, Socrates fell victim to the wrath of the fathers over his 'seduction of youth', and Plato for that reason considered it necessary to institute a whole new state if the existence of the philosopher was not to be imperilled by the unreason of the fathers. It almost looks now as though Plato really did achieve something. For the modern state regards the promotion of philosophy as among its tasks and seeks at all times to bless a number of men with that 'freedom' which we understand as the most essential condition for the genesis of the philosopher. But historically speaking Plato has been singularly unfortunate: as soon as a structure has appeared which has essentially corresponded to his proposals, it has always turned out on close examination to be a changeling, an ugly elf-child; such as the medieval priestly state was by comparison with the rule of the 'sons of god' he had dreamed of. The last thing the modern state wants to do, of course, is to install philosophers as rulers' God be praised! every Christian will add -: but even promotion of philosophy as the state understands it will one day have to be inspected to see whether the state understands it Platonically, which is to say as seriously and honestly as though its highest objective were to produce new Platos. If the philosopher as a rule appears in his age by chance - does the state now really set itself the task of consciously translating this fortuitousness into necessity and here too rendering assistance to nature? 183 Experience unfortunately teaches us better - or rather, worse: it tells us that nothing stands so much in the way of the production and propagation of the great philosopher by nature as does the bad philosopher who works for the state. A painful fact, is it not? recognizably the same as that to which Schopenhauer first directed attention in his celebrated treatise on university philosophy. I shall return to it later: for one has to compel men to take it seriously, that is to say to let it inspire them to action, and I consider every word behind which there does not stand such a challenge to action to have been written in vain; and it is in any event a good thing again to demonstrate the truth of Schopenhauer's always valid propositions, and to do so by direct reference to our closest contemporaries, since a well-disposed man might think that since he launched his accusations everything has taken a turn for the better in Germany. Even on this point, minor though it is, his work is not

yet done. Considered more closely, that 'freedom' with which, as I have said, the state now blesses some men for the good of philosophy is no freedom at all but an office of. profit. The promotion of philosophy nowadays consists, it seems, only in the state's enabling a number of men to live from their philosophy by making of it a means of livelihood: whereas the sages of ancient Greece were not paid by the state but at most were, like Zeno, honoured with a gold crown and a monument in the Ceramicus. Whether truth is served when one is shown a way of living off it I cannot say in general, because here it all depends on the quality of the individual who is shown it. I could well envisage a degree of pride and self-esteem which would lead a man to say to his fellow-men: look after me, for I have some thing better to do, namely to look after you. In the case of Plato or Schopenhauer, such grandeur of disposition and expression would not alienate one; which is why precisely they could even be university philosophers, as Plato was for a time a court philosopher, without demeaning the dignity of philosophy. But even Kant was, as we scholars are accustomed to be, cautious, subservient and, in his attitude towards the state, without greatness: so that, if university philosophy should ever be called to account, he at any rate could not justify it. And if there are natures capable of justifying it - such natures as those of Schopenhauer and Plato - I fear they will never have occasion for doing so, since no state would ever dare to favour such men and install them in university posts. Why is that so? Because every state fears them and will favour only philosophers it does not fear. For it does happen that the state is afraid of philosophy 184 Schopenhauer as educator as such, and when this is the case it will try all the more to draw to it philosophers who will give it the appearance of having philosophy on its side - because it has on its side those men who bear the name of philosopher and yet are patently nothing to inspire fear. If, however, a man should arise who really gave the impression of intending to apply the seal of truth to all things, including the body of the state, then the state would, since it affirms its own existence before all else, be justified in expelling such a man and treating him as an enemy: just as it expels and treats as an enemy a religion which sets itself above the state and desires to be its judge. So if any one is to tolerate being a philosopher in the employ of the state, he will also have to tolerate being regarded as having abandoned any attempt to pursue truth into all its hideouts. At the very least he is obliged, so long as he is the recipient of favours and offices, to recognize something as being higher than truth, namely the state. And not merely the state but at the same time everything the state considers necessary for its wellbeing: a certain form of religion, for example, or of social order, or of army regulations - a *noli me tangere* * is inscribed upon everything of this sort. Can a university philosopher ever have realized to the full the whole gamut of duties and limitations imposed upon him? I do not know; if he has done so and has nonetheless remained an official of the state he has been a

bad friend of truth; if he has never done so - well, I would say he would still be no friend of truth. This is the most general objection: to people as they are now, however, it is of course the weakest objection and the one to which they are most indifferent. Most will be content to shrug their shoulders and say: 'as though anything great and pure has ever been able to maintain itself on this earth without making concessions to human baseness! Would you prefer it if the state persecuted the philosopher rather than paid him and took him into service?' Without immediately replying to this-question, I shall only observe that these concessions to the state on the part of philosophy go very far at the present time. Firstly: it is the state which selects its philosophical servants, and which selects just the number it needs to supply its institutions; it therefore takes on the appearance of being able to distinguish between good philosophers and bad ones and, even worse, it presupposes that there must always be a sufficiency of good philosophers to fill all its academic chairs. It is now the authority, not only with regard to the quality of philosophers, but also in "noli me tangere: do not touch me" I regard to how many good philosophers are needed. Secondly: it compels those it has chosen to reside in a certain place, to live among certain people, to undertake a certain activity; they are obliged to instruct every academic youth who desires instruction, and to do so daily at certain fixed hours. Question: can a philosopher really undertake with a good conscience to have something to teach every day? And to teach it to anyone who cares to listen? Will he not be obliged to give the impression of knowing more than he does know? Will he not be obliged to speak before an audience of strangers of things which he can safely speak of only among his nearest friends? And speaking generally: is he not robbing himself of his freedom to follow his genius whenever and wherever it calls him? - through being obligated to think in public about predetermined subjects at predetermined hours? And to do so before youths! Is such thinking not as it were emasculated from the first! Supposing one day he said to himself: I can't think of anything today, at least not of anything worthwhile - he would still have to present himself and pretend to think! But, you will object, he is not supposed to be a thinker at all, but at most a learned presenter of what others have thought: and as to that, he will always have something to say his pupils do not already know. - But precisely this - to undertake to appear first and foremost as scholarliness - is the third perilous concession which philosophy makes to the state. Above all when it appears as knowledge of the history of philosophy: for to the genius, who gazes upon things as a poet does, with pure and loving eyes, and cannot immerse himself too deeply in them, grubbing around in countless strange and perverse opinions is the most repugnant and inappropriate occupation imaginable. The learned history of the past has never been the business of a true philosopher, neither in India nor in Greece; and if a professor of philosophy involves himself in such work he

must at best be content to have it said of him: he is a fine classical scholar, antiquary, linguist, historian - but never: he is a philosopher. And that, as remarked, is only at best: for most of the learned work done by university philosophers seems to a classicist to be done badly, without scientific rigour and mostly with a detestable tediousness. Who, for example, can clear the history of the Greek philosophers of the soporific miasma spread over it by the learned, though not particularly scientific and unfortunately all too tedious, labours of Ritter, Brandis and Zeller? I for one prefer reading Laertius Diogenes to Zeller, because the former at least breathes the spirit of the 186 Schopenhauer as educator philosophers of antiquity, while the latter breathes neither that nor any other spirit. And finally, what in the world have our young men to do with the history of philosophy? Is the confusion of opinions supposed to discourage them from having opinions of their own? Are they supposed to learn how to join in the rejoicing at how wonderfully far we ourselves have come? Are they supposed even to learn to hate philosophy or to despise it? One might almost think so when one knows how students have to torment themselves for the sake of their philosophical examinations so as to cram into their poor brain the maddest and most caustic notions of the human spirit together with the greatest and hardest to grasp. The only critique of a philosophy that is possible and that proves something, namely trying to see whether one can live in accordance with it, has never been taught at universities: all that has ever been taught is a critique of words by means of other words. And now imagine a youthful head, not very experienced in living, in which fifty systems in the form of words and fifty critiques of them are preserved side-by-side and intermingled - what a desert, what a return to barbarism, what a mockery of an education in philosophy! But of course it is admittedly no such thing; it is a training in passing philosophical examinations, the usual outcome of which is well known to be that the youth to be tested - tested all too severely, alas! - admits to himself with a sigh of relief: 'Thank God I am no philosopher, but a Christian and a citizen of my country!' What if this sigh of relief were the state's actual objective and 'education in philosophy' only a means of deterring from philosophy? Let one ask oneself this question. - If it really is so, however, there is only one thing to be feared: that youth may one day finally come to realize to what end philosophy is here being misused. The supreme objective, the production of the philosophical genius, nothing but a pretext? The goal perhaps the prevention of his production? The meaning of it all reversed into its opposite? In that case - woe to the whole complex of state and professorial policy! - And is something of the sort not supposed to have transpired already? I do not know; but I do know that university philosophy is now the object of universal disrespect and scepticism. This is in part due to the fact that a feeble race now holds sway over the lecture room; and if Schopenhauer had to write his treatise on university philosophy

now, he would no longer have need of the club but would conquer with a reed. They are the heirs and progeny of those pseudo-thinkers whose much-turned heads he battered: their 1 87 appearance is sufficiently infantile and dwarfish for us t'o be reminded of the Indian saying: 'Men are born, in accordance with their deeds, stupid, dumb, deaf, misshapen.' Their fathers deserved such a progeny by virtue of their 'deeds', as the saying has it. That is why it is quite indisputable that academic youth will very soon be able to manage without the philosophy taught: at their universities, and that unacademic men are already able to manage without it. One has only to recall one's own student days; in my case, for example, academic philosophers were men towards whom I was perfectly indifferent: I counted them as people who raked together something for themselves out of the results of the other sciences and employed their leisure time in reading newspapers and going to concerts, and for the rest were treated by their own academic comrades with a politely masked contempt. They were credited with knowing little and with never being at a loss for some obscure expression with which to conceal this lack of knowledge. They thus preferred to dwell in gloomy places where the clear-eyed cannot endure to be for long. One of them urged it against thj natural sciences: none of them can completely explain to me the simplest process of becoming, so what have any of them to do with me? Another said of history: to him who has ideas it has nothing new to say - in short, they always discovered reasons why it was more philosophical to know nothing than to learn something. If they did engage in learning, their secret motive in doing so was to elude science and to found a dark domain in one or other of its lacunae. Thus they went on ahead of the sciences only in the sense that the deer is ahead of the huntsmen who are after it. Lately they have been content to assert that they are really no more than the frontier guards and spies of the sciences; to which end they are especially served by the teachings of Kant, out of which they are intent upon fashioning an idle scepticism that will soon be of no interest to anybody. Only now and then does one of them still hoist himself up to a little system of metaphysics, with the consequences that usually follow, namely dizziness, headache and nosebleed. After having so often enjoyed no success on this trip into the mist and clouqs, after some rude, hard-headed disciple of the real sciences has again and again seized them by the pigtail and pulled them back down, their face habitually assumes an expression of primness and of having been found out. They have lost their confidence, so that none of them lives even a moment for the sake of his philosophy. Formerly some of them believed themselves capable of inventing new religions or of replacing old ones with their philosophical sys- 1 88 Schopenhauer as educator terns; nowadays they have lost all this old arrogance and are as a rule pious, timid and uncertain folk, never brave like Lucretius or wrath ful at human oppression. Neither can one any longer learn from them how to think logically and, with a correct estimation of

their powers, they have ceased the formal disputations they used to practise. It is indisputable that the individual sciences are now pursued more logically, cautiously, modestly, inventively, in short more philosophically, than is the case with so-called philosophers: so that everyone will agree with the impartial Englishman Bagehot when he says of our contemporary system-builders: 'Who is not almost sure beforehand that they will contain a strange mixture of truth and error, and therefore that it will not be worthwhile to spend life in reasoning over their consequences? The mass of a system attracts the young and impresses the unwary; but cultivated people are very dubious about it. They are ready to receive hints and suggestions and the smallest real truth is ever welcome. But a large book of deductive philosophy is much to be suspected. Unproved abstract principles without number have been eagerly caught up by sanguine men and then carefully spun out into books and theories which were to explain the whole world. The world goes totally against these abstractions, and it must do so since they require it to go in antagonistic directions.'¶ If formerly philosophers, especially in Germany, used to be sunk in such profound reflection that they were in constant danger of hitting their head on a beam, they are now supplied with a whole regiment of flappers, such as Swift describes in the Voyage to Laputa, to give them a gentle blow now and then on the eyes or elsewhere. Sometimes these blows may be a little too heavy, on which occasions the enraptured thinker can easily forget himself and hit back - something that always results in his discomfiture. Can't you see the beam, you sleepy-head! the flapper then says - and often the philosopher really does see the beam and becomes tractable again. These flappers are history and the natural sciences; they have gradually come so to overawe the German dream- and thought-business which was for long confused with philosophy that these thought-mongers would be only too glad to abandon any attempt at an independent existence; if however they should happen to impede the former or try to fasten leading-strings on to them, the flappers at once start to flap as violently as they can - as though they *

Quoted from Bagehot's *Physics and Politics*. The order of the sentences in the original passage is inverted in Nietzsche's quotation of it, but this appears not to affect the meaning. 189 wanted to say: 'For a thought-monger like this to profane our history or natural sciences would be the last straw! Away with him!' Then they totter back into their own uncertainty and perplexity: they really do want to get a little natural science into their possession, perhaps like the Herbartians in the shape of empirical psychology, they really do want a little history as well - then they can act, at least in public, as though they were engaged in scientific undertakings, even though in private they would like to consign all philosophy and science to the devil. But granted that this troop of bad philosophers is ludicrous - and who will not grant it? - to what extent are they also harmful? The answer, in brief, is: to the extent that they make philosophy

itself ludicrous. As long as this officially recognized guild of pseudo-thinkers continues to exist, any effectiveness of a true philosophy will be brought to naught or at least obstructed, and it will suffer this fate through no thing other than the curse of the ludicrous which the representatives of that philosophy have called down upon themselves but which also strikes at philosophy itself. That is why I say it is a demand of culture that philosophy should be deprived of any kind of official or academic recognition and that state and academy be relieved of the task, which they cannot encompass, of distinguishing between real and apparent philosophy. Let the philosophers grow untended, deny them all prospect of place and position within the bourgeois professions, cease to entice them with salaries, more, persecute them, show them disfavour you will behold miracles! The poor seeming philosophers will flee apart and seek a roof wherever they can find it; one will become a parson, another a schoolmaster, a third will creep into the shelter of an editorial job on a newspaper, a fourth will write instruction manuals for girls' high schools, the most sensible of them will take up the plough and the vainest will go to court. Suddenly it will all be empty, everyone will have flown the nest: for it is easy to get rid of bad philosophers, one only has to cease rewarding them. And that is in any event more advisable than for the state publicly to patronize any philosophy, whichever it may be. The state never has any use for truth as such, but only for truth which is useful to it, more precisely for anything whatever useful to it whether it be truth, half-truth or error. A union of state and philosophy can therefore make sense only if philosophy can promise to be unconditionally useful to the state, that is to say, to set usefulness to the state higher than truth. It would of course be splendid for the state if it also had truth in its pay and service; but the state itself 190 Schopenhauer as educator well knows that it is part of the essence of truth that it never accepts pay or stands in anyone's service. Thus what the state has is only false 'truth', a person in a mask; and unfortunately this cannot do for it what it so much desires genuine truth to do: validate and sanctify it. It is true that if a medieval prince wanted to be crowned by the Pope but the Pope refused to do it, he nominated an anti-Pope who then perfunctored for him this service. This might have worked then to some extent; but for a modern state to nominate an anti-philosophy to legitimize it will not work: for it will still have philosophy against it as before, and now more than before. I believe in all seriousness that it is more useful to the state to have nothing at all to do with philosophy, to desire nothing from it and for as long as possible to regard it as something to which it is completely indifferent. If this condition of indifference does not endure, if it becomes dangerous and hostile to the state, then let the state persecute it. - Since the state can have no interest in the university other than seeing it raise useful and devoted citizens of the state, it should hesitate to place this usefulness and devotion in jeopardy by demanding that these young men should sit an examination in philosophy: it could well be,

of course, that the dull and incompetent would be frightened off university study altogether by this spectre of a philosophy examination; but this gain could not compensate for the harm done to rash and restless youth by this enforced drudgery; they get to know books forbidden them, begin to criticize their teachers and finally even become aware of the objective of university philosophy and its examinations - not to speak of the misgivings which this circumstance can excite in young theologians and as a result of which they are beginning to die out in Germany, as the ibex is in the Tyrol. I understand well enough the objections the state could have raised against this whole way of looking at things so long as the fair green shoots of Hegelianism were sprouting up in every field: but now that this harvest has come to nothing, all the expectations built upon it have proved vain and all the barns remained empty - one prefers no longer to raise objections but to turn away from philosophy altogether. One now possesses power: formerly, in Hegel's time, one wanted to possess it - that is a vast distinction. Philosophy has become superfluous to the state because the state no longer needs its sanction. If the state no longer maintains its professors or, as I foresee in the near future, appears to maintain them but in fact neglects them, it derives advantage from doing so - yet it appears to me of more importance that the universities should see it is to their benefit too. At least I would think that an institution for the real sciences must see it is good for it no longer to have to keep company with a semi-science. The universities enjoy so little regard, moreover, they must on principle desire the exclusion of disciplines which academics themselves hold in low esteem. For non-academics have good reason for a certain general disrespect for universities; they reproach them with being cowardly, since the small ones fear the big ones and the big ones fear public opinion; with failing to take the lead in questions of higher culture but limping slowly and tardily in the rear, with ceasing to maintain the respected sciences on their true course. Linguistic studies, for example, are pursued more zealously than ever, but no one considers it necessary to educate himself in correct writing and speaking. Indian antiquity is opening its gates, yet the relationship of those who study it to the imperishable works of the Indians, to their philosophies, hardly differs from that of an animal to a lyre: even though Schopenhauer considered its acquaintance with Indian philosophy the greatest advantage our century possessed over all others. Classical antiquity has become a take-it-or-leave-it antiquity and has ceased to produce a classic and exemplary effect; a fact demonstrated by its disciples, who are truly not exemplary. Whither has the spirit of Friedrich August Wolf departed, of which Franz Passow could say it appeared a genuinely patriotic, genuinely human spirit which, if it needed to, possessed the force to set a continent on fire and in ferment - where has this spirit gone? On the other hand, the spirit of the journalist is penetrating the universities more and more, and not seldom under the name of philosophy; a

smooth, highly coloured mode of address, Faust and Nathan the Wise constantly invoked, the language and views of our nauseating literary journals, lately even chattering about our sacred German music and the demand for chairs for the study of Goethe and Schiller - all signs that the spirit of the university is beginning to confuse itself with the Zeitgeist. It thus seems to me of the first importance that there should be created out side the universities a higher tribunal whose function would be to supervise and judge these institutions in regard to the education they are promoting; and as soon as philosophy departs from the universities, and therewith purifies itself of all unworthy considerations and prejudices, it must constitute precisely such a tribunal: devoid of official authority, without salaries or honours, it will know how to perform its duty free of the Zeitgeist and free from fear of it - in short, as Schopenhauer lived, as the judge of the so-called culture around him. In this way the philosopher, if instead of amalgamating with it he supervises it from a dignified distance, is able to be of use to the university. Finally, however - of what concern to us is the existence of the state, the promotion of universities, when what matters above all is the existence of philosophy on earth! or - to leave absolutely no doubt as to what I think - if it is so unspeakably more vital that a philosopher should appear on earth than that a state or a university' should continue to exist. The dignity of philosophy can increase in the measure that servitude to public opinion and the danger to freedom increases; it was at its greatest during the earthquake attending the fall of the Roman republic and during the imperial era, when its name and that of history became ingrata principibus nomina. * Brutus demonstrates more for its dignity than does Plato; he belonged to an age in which ethics ceased to be platitudinous. If philosophy is little regarded at present, one ought only to ask why it is that no great general or statesman at present has anything to do with it - the answer is simply that at the time he sought it he encountered a feeble phantom bearing the name of philosophy, a scholarly lecture-hall wisdom and lecture-hall cautiousness; in short, it is because in his early years philosophy became to him something ludicrous. What it ought to be to him, however, is something fear some, and men called to the search for power ought to know what a source of the heroic wells within it. Let an American tell them what a great thinker who arrives on this earth signifies as a new centre of tremendous forces. 'Beware', says Emerson, 'when the great God lets loose a thinker on this planet. Then all things are at risk. It is as when a conflagration has broken out in a great city, and no man knows what is safe, or where it will end. There is not a piece of science but its flank may be turned tomorrow; there is not any literary reputation, not the so-called eternal names of fame, that may not be revised and condemned; the things which are dear to men at this hour are so on account of the ideas which have emerged on their mental horizon, and which cause the present order of things, as a tree bears

its apples. A new degree of culture would instantly revolutionize the entire system of human pursuits.¹ Now, if such thinkers are dangerous, it is of course clear why our academic thinkers are not dangerous; for their thoughts grow as peacefully out of tradition as **ingrata principibus nomina*: names displeasing to princes (quoted from Emerson's essay entitled 'Circles').¹⁹³ Any tree ever bore its apples: they cause no alarm, they remove no thing from its hinges; and of all their art and aims there could be said what Diogenes said when someone praised a philosopher in his presence: 'How can he be considered great, since he has been a philosopher for so long and has never yet disturbed anybody?' That, indeed, ought to be the epitaph of university philosophy: 'it disturbed nobody'. But this, of course, is praise of an old woman rather than of the goddess of truth, and it is not to be wondered at if those who know that goddess only as an old woman are themselves very unmanly and thus, as might be expected, completely ignored by the men of power. But if this is how things stand in our time, then the dignity of philosophy is trampled into the dust; it has even become something ludicrous, it would seem, or a matter of complete indifference to anyone: so that it is the duty of all its true friends to bear witness against this confusion, and at the least to show that it is only its false and unworthy servants who are ludicrous or a matter of indifference. It would be better still if they demonstrated by their deeds that love of truth is something fearsome and mighty. Schopenhauer demonstrated both these things - and will demonstrate them more and more as day succeeds day.¹⁹⁴ Richard Wagner in Bayreuth I For an event to possess greatness two things must come together: greatness of spirit in those who accomplish it and greatness of spirit in those who experience it. No event possesses greatness in itself, though it involve the disappearance of whole constellations, the destruction of entire peoples, the foundation of vast states or the prosecution of wars involving tremendous forces and tremendous losses: the breath of history has blown away many things of that kind as though they were flakes of snow. It can also happen that a man of force accomplishes a deed which strikes a reef and sinks from sight having produced no impression; a brief, sharp echo, and all is over. History has virtually nothing to report about such as it were truncated and neutralized events. And so whenever we see an event approaching we are overcome with the fear that those who will experience it will be unworthy of it. Whenever one acts, in small things as in great, one always has in view this correspondence between deed and receptivity; and he who gives must see to it that he finds recipients adequate to the meaning of his gift. This is why even the individual deed of a man great in himself lacks greatness if it is brief and without resonance or effect; for at the moment he performed it he must have been in error as to its necessity at precisely that time: he failed to take correct aim and chance became master over him - whereas to be great and to possess a clear grasp of necessity have always belonged strictly together. We can therefore

happily leave any dubiety as to whether that which is now taking place in Bayreuth is necessary and taking place at the right time to those who doubt Wagner's grasp of necessity itself. To us with greater faith it must seem that he believes in the greatness of his deed just as he does in the greatness of those who are to experience it. All to whom this belief is accorded should feel proud of the fact, whether they be few or many - for that it is not accorded to everyone, neither to the whole of our age nor even to the German people as it stands at present, he told us himself in his dedicatory address of 22 May 1872; and though to contradict him in this would be a consolation to him, none of us dares do it. 'When I sought those who would sympathize with my plans,' he said then, 'I had only you, the friends of my particular art, my most personal work and creation, to turn to: it was only from you that I could expect assistance in presenting this work in pure and undisfigured form to those who had demonstrated a serious interest in my art even though it had hitherto been presented to them only in impure and disfigured form.' In Bayreuth the spectator too is worth seeing, there is no doubt about that. A wise observer who moved from one century to another to compare noteworthy cultural movements would have much to see there; he would feel as though he had suddenly entered warmer water, like one swimming in a lake who approaches a current from a hot spring: this water must be coming from other, deeper sources, he says to himself, the water around it, which has in any case a shallower origin, does not account for it. Thus all those who attend the Bayreuth Festival will be felt to be untimely men: their home is not in this age but elsewhere, and it is elsewhere too that their explanation and justification is to be found. It has grown ever clearer to me that the 'cultivated person', insofar as he is wholly the product of this present age, can approach all that Wagner does and thinks only when it is presented to him in the shape of parody - as every thing Wagner does and thinks has indeed been parodied - and that he will let the event at Bayreuth too be illumined for him only by the very unmagical lantern of our facetious newspaper journalists. And we shall be lucky if it stops at parody! For there is in it a spirit of alienation and hostility that could seek quite different ways of discharging itself, and has on occasion done so. Such an uncommon degree of sharpness and tension between opposites would likewise attract the attention of this cultural observer. That a single individual could, in the course of an average human lifespan, produce something altogether new may well excite the indignation of those who cleave to the gradualness of all evolution as though to a kind of moral law: they themselves are slow and demand slowness in others - and here they see someone moving very fast, do not know how he does it, and are angry with him. For such an undertaking as that at Bayreuth there were no warning signs, no transitional events, nothing intermediate; the long path to the goal, and the goal itself, none knew but Wagner. It is the first circumnavigation of the world in the domain of "

Spoken at the ceremony attending the laying of the foundation stone of the Festival Theatre at Bayreuth. 1 98 Richard Wagner in Bayreuth art: as a result of which, as it seems, there has been discovered not only a new art but an itself. All the arts of modern times have, as isolated and stunted or as luxury arts, been almost disvalued; and the uncertain, ill coordinated recollections of a true art which we moderns have derived from the Greeks may now also rest in peace, except insofar as they are now able to shine of themselves in the light of a new understanding. For many things the time has come to die out; this new art is a prophet which sees the end approaching for other things than the arts. Its admonishing hand must make a very disquieting impression upon our entire contemporary culture as soon as the laughter provoked by parodies of it has subsided: let the merriment go on for a little while yet! We, on the other hand, we disciples of an resurrected, will have the time and the will for profound, serious reflection! The noise and chatter which has hitherto gone on about an we are bound to find shamelessly imponunate from now on; everything imposes upon us silence, the five-year silence of the Pythagoreans. Who of us has not dirtied his hands and heart in the service of the idols of modern cul ture? Who is not in need of the water of purification, who does not hear the voice that admonished him: be silent and be cleansed! be silent and be cleansed! Only as those who listen to this voice are we also granted the mighty insight with which we have to view the event at Bayreuth, and only in this insight does there lie the mighty future of that event. When on that day in the May of 1 872 the foundation stone was laid on the hill at Bayreuth amid pouring rain and under a darkened sky, Wagner drove with some of us back to the town; he was silent and he seemed to be gazing into himself with a look not to be described in words. It was the first day of his sixtieth year: everything that had gone before was a preparation for this moment. We know that at times of exceptional danger, or in general at any decisive turning point of their lives, men compress together all they have experienced in an infinitely accelerated inner panorama, and behold distant events as sharply as they do the most recent ones. What may Alexander the Great not have seen in the moment he caused Asia and Europe to be drunk out of the same cup? What Wagner beheld within him on that day, however - how he became what he is and what he will be we who are closest to him can to a certain extent also see: and it is only from this Wagnerian inner view that we shall be able to under stand his great deed itself - and with this understanding guarantee its fruitfulness. 1 99 It would be strange if that which a man can do best and most likes to do failed to become a visible presence within the total formation of his life; and in the case of men of exceptional abilities their life must become not only a reflection of their character, as is the case with everyone, but first and foremost a reflection of their intellect and of the capacities most personal to them. The life of the epic poet will have something of the epic about it as is the case with Goethe, by the way, whom

the Germans insist, quite wrongly, in seeing as principally a lyric poet - and the life of the dramatist will take a dramatic course. The dramatic element in Wagner's development is quite unmistakable from the moment when his ruling passion became aware of itself and took his whole nature in its charge: from that time on there was an end to fumbling, straying, to the proliferation of secondary shoots, and within the most convoluted courses and often daring trajectories assumed by his artistic plans there rules a single inner law, a will, by which they can be explained, however strange this explanation will often sound. But there was also a pre-dramatic era in Wagner's life, that of his childhood and Youth, and one cannot pass this era in review without encountering riddles. He himself does not yet seem to be present at all and that which, with hindsight, one might perhaps interpret as a sign of his presence appears at first as the simultaneous existence of qualities which must excite misgivings rather than hopeful anticipation: a spirit of restlessness, of irritability, a nervous hastiness in seizing hold upon a hundred different things, a passionate delight in experiencing moods of almost pathological intensity, an abrupt transition from the most soulful quietude to noise and violence. He was held in check by no traditional family involvement in any particular art: he might as easily have adopted painting, poetry, acting, music as academic scholarship or an academic future; and a superficial view of him might suggest that he was a born dilettante. The little world under whose spell he grew up was not such as one could have congratulated an artist on having for a homeland. He was very close to enjoying the perilous pleasure in the superficial tasting of one thing after another in the intellectual realm, as he was to the self-conceit engendered by much superficial knowledge which is commonplace in cities of scholars; his sensibilities were easily aroused and as easily satisfied; wherever the eyes of the boy rested he saw himself surrounded by a strangely pre-Richard Wagner in Bayreuth cocoon . yet animated existence to which the gaudy world of the theatre stood in a ludicrous, and the soul-compelling sound of music in an incomprehensible, contrast. Now, it is in general remarkable that, when a modern man is gifted with a great talent, he seldom possesses in his youth and childhood the quality of naivety, of simply being himself; and that when, in such rare cases as Goethe and Wagner, he does attain to naivety, he does so in adulthood. The artist especially, in whom the power of imitation is particularly strong, must fall prey to the feeble many-sidedness of modern life as to a serious childhood illness; in his youth and childhood · he will look more like an adult than his real self. The marvellously accurate archetypal youth who is the Siegfried of the Ring des Nibelungen * could have been produced only by a man, and by a man moreover who had found his own youth late in life. And as Wagner's youth came late, so did his full maturity; so that in this respect at least he is the opposite of an anticipatory nature. As soon as his spiritual and moral maturity arrives, the drama of his life

also begins. And how different he looks now! His nature appears in a fearful way simplified, torn apart into two drives or spheres. Below there rages the precipitate current of a vehement will which as it were strives to reach up to the light through every runway, cave and crevice, and desires power. Only a force wholly pure and free could direct this will on to the pathway to the good and benevolent; had it been united with a narrow spirit, such an unbridled tyrannical will could have become a fatality; and a way out into the open, into air and sunlight, was in any event bound to be found soon. A mighty striving conscious of repeated failure makes one bad; inadequacy can sometimes be inherent in circumstances, * The Nibelung's Ring, the tetralogy for the performance of which Wagner designed and erected the Festival Theatre at Bayreuth, in Bavaria, and the first performance of which inaugurated the Bayreuth Festival. Wagner designated the Ring a 'Stage Festival Drama for Three Days and a Fore-Evening'. The 'Fore-Evening' is *Das Rheingold* (The Rhine-Gold), a music-drama in a single act (four scenes); the first 'day' is *Die Walküre* (The Valkyrie), a music-drama in three acts; the second 'day' is *Siegfried*, also in three acts; and the third 'day' is *Götterdämmerung* (Twilight of the Gods), in three acts and a prologue. The whole work takes between 1 5 and 1 6 hours to perform, depending on the tempo of performance, and is the longest musical composition in existence (The Rhine-Gold, which runs for about two-and-a-half hours, is the longest uninterrupted musical movement). The present essay was published in July 1 876 to coincide with the inauguration of the festival, which took place on 13, 14, 1 6 and 1 7 August with the first public performance of the Ring. 20 1 in the unalterability of fate, and not in lack of force; but he who can not cease from striving in spite of this insufficiency becomes as it were embittered and thus irritable and unjust. Perhaps he seeks the cause of his lack of success in others; he can, indeed, with a passionate hatred treat all the world as being to blame for it; perhaps he goes off defiantly along sidepaths and into subterfuges, or takes to violence: thus it happens that benevolent natures turn savage on their way to a laudable goal. Even among those whose objective is only their own moral purification, among hermits and monks, there are to be found such savage and morbid men, hollowed out and consumed by failure. It was a spirit full of love, with voice overflowing with goodness and sweetness, with a hatred of violence and self destruction, which desires to see no one in chains - it was such a spirit that spoke to Wagner. It descended upon him, covered him with its wings, and showed him the path. We are now taking a look into the other sphere of Wagner's nature: but how are we to describe it? The figures which an artist creates are not he himself, but a succession of figures upon whom he has patently bestowed his love does tell us at any rate something about the artist himself. Now call to mind Rienzi, the Flying Dutchman and Senta, Tannhäuser and Elizabeth, Lohengrin and Elsa, Tristan and Marke, Hans Sachs, Wotan and Brinnhilde: there passes

through all of them a subterranean current of moral ennoblement and enlargement which unites them, a current which flows ever more clear and pure - and here, if with shy reserve, we stand before a development in the innermost recesses of Wagner's own soul. In what artist can we perceive anything similar at a similar peak of greatness? Schiller's figures, from the Robbers to Wallenstein and Tell, go through such a course of ennoblement and likewise express something of the development of their creator, but Wagner's standard is higher and the course is longer. Everything participates in this purification and expresses it, not only the myth but also the music; in the Ring des Nibelungen I discover the most moral music I know, for example when Brinnhilde is awoken by Siegfried; here he attains to an elevation and sanctity of mood that makes us think of the glowing ice- and snow-covered peaks of the Alps, so pure, solitary, inaccessible, chaste and bathed in the light of love does nature appear here; clouds and storms, even the sublime itself, are beneath it. Looking back from this vantage point upon Tannhauser and the Dutchman, we feel how Wagner evolved: how he started darkly and restlessly, how he stormily Richard Wagner in Bayreuth sought relief, strove for power and intoxication, often flew back in disgust, how he wanted to throw off his burden, longed to forget, to deny, to renounce - the entire stream plunged now into this valley, now into that, and bored its way into the darkest ravines: - in the night of this half-subterranean turmoil a star appeared high above him shining with a sad light, and he named it for what he recognized it to be: loyalty, selfless loyalty! Why did it seem to him to shine more brightly and purely than any other? what secret does the word loyalty hold for his whole being? For the image and problem of loyalty is impressed upon everything he thought and created; there exists in his works a virtually complete series of all possible kinds of loyalty, the most glorious and rarest among them: loyalty of brother to sister, of friend to friend, of servant to master, Elizabeth to Tannhauser, Senta to the Dutchman, Elsa to Lohengrin, Isolde, Kurwenal and Marke to Tristan, Brinnhilde to Wotan's innermost desire - to make only a start on the series. It is the most personal primal event that Wagner experiences within himself and reveres like a religious mystery: he expresses it in the word loyalty and he never wearies of displaying it in a hundred shapes and, in the abundance of his gratitude, of bestowing upon it the finest things he possesses and the finest he can do - that marvellous experience and recognition that one sphere of his being remains loyal to the other, shows loyalty out of free and most selfless love, the creative, innocent, more illuminated sphere to the dark, intractable and tyrannical. It was in the relationship of these two profound forces with one another, in the surrender of the one to the other, that there lay the great necessity which had to be fulfilled if he was to be whole and wholly himself: at the same time it was the only act that did not lie in his own power, which he could only watch and endure, while the

possibility of seduction to disloyalty, and the frightful danger it represented to him, was always present. In the uncertainty that thus arose there lay an abundant source of suffering. Each of his drives strove without limit, each of his talents, joyful in its existence, wanted to tear itself free from the others and satisfy itself individually; the greater their abundance, the greater was the tumult and the greater the hostility when they crossed one another. In addition there was the impulse, deriving from chance and from life itself, to acquire power, fame, pleasure, and he was tormented even more frequently by the inexorable need to earn a living: traps and fetters lay everywhere. How is it possible to stay loyal, to remain whole, under these conditions? - This doubt often overcame him, and then, as would happen with an artist, found expression in the figures of his art: Elizabeth can only suffer, pray and die for Tannhauser, she saves the restless and immoderate man through her loyalty, but not for this life. Danger and despair lie in wait for every true artist thrown into the modern world. He can acquire honours and power in many forms, he is frequently offered peace and contentment, but always only in the shape in which they are known to modern man and in which to the honest artist they must become choking foul air. It is in the temptation to this, and likewise in resistance to this temptation, that his danger lies; in disgust with the modern manner of acquiring pleasure and reputation, in rage at all self-seeking contentment in the manner of modern man. Think of him occupying an official position, as Wagner had to fill the office of conductor at town and court theatres; we can see how the most tiresome artist will try forcibly to impose seriousness on the institution of which he is part, an institution which has, however, been constructed frivolously and demands frivolity almost as a matter of principle; how he partially succeeds but in the end always fails; how he begins to feel disgust and wants to flee; how he fails to find anywhere to flee to, and is again and again obliged to return to the gypsies and outcasts of our culture as one of them. If he frees himself from one situation he rarely finds a better, and sometimes he is plunged into the direst need. Thus Wagner moves from town to town, companion to companion, country to country, and one hardly knows what it was in each of them that kept him there for as long as it did. A heavy atmosphere lies over the greater part of his life hitherto; he seems to have abandoned any general hopes and to have lived from day to day: and thus he eluded despair, but at the price of abandoning belief. He must often have felt like a wanderer in the night, heavily burdened and profoundly exhausted, who is yet each night revitalized; sudden death then appeared to his eyes, not as something to fear, but as an alluring spectre. Burden, pathway and night, all gone in a trice! - that was a seductive idea. A hundred times he threw himself back into life with short-breathed hope and put all spectres behind him. But he almost always did so with an immoderation which revealed that he placed no great faith in this hope but was only intoxicating himself with it. The contrast

between his desires and his incapacity to fulfil them was Richard Wagner in Bayreuth a goad tormenting him; exasperated by continual deprivation, his judgment gave way to excess whenever his poverty was for once suddenly eased. His life became ever more complicated; but the expedients by means of which he handled it became ever bolder and more inventive, though they were in fact merely the emergency actions of the dramatist, designed to deceive only for a moment. As soon as he needs them he has them, and they are used up just as quickly. Seen from close to and without love, Wagner's life has, to recall an idea of Schopenhauer's, much of the comedy about it, and markedly grotesque comedy at that. How the feeling and recognition that whole stretches of his life are marked by a grotesque lack of dignity must affect an artist who, more than any other, can breathe freely only in the sublime and more than sublime - that is something for the thinker to reflect on. In the midst of all this activity, of which only a detailed account can evoke the degree of pity, horror and admiration it deserves, there was unfolded a talent for learning quite extraordinary even among Germans, the nation most gifted in learning; and in this talent there again appeared a danger even greater than that attending a life apparently unstable and rootless and confusedly directed by restless illusion. From an experimenting novice Wagner grew into an omniscient master of music and of the stage and in all technical matters an innovator and developer. No one will any longer contest that he has provided the supreme model for all art in the grand manner. But he became even more, and to become it he was spared as little as anyone else would be the task of appropriating to himself all that is highest in culture. And how he did it! It is a joy to see; he acquired and absorbed it from all sides, and the bigger and heavier the structure became, the firmer grew the arch of thought that was to order and control it. And yet it has rarely been made so hard for anyone to discover the way into the sciences and skills, and often he had to improvise these ways in for himself. The rejuvenator of the simple drama, the discoverer of the place of the arts in a true human society, the poetic elucidator of past philosophies of life, the philosopher, the historian, the aesthetician and critic, the master of language, the mythologist and mytho-poet who for the first time enclosed the whole glorious, primeval structure within a ring and carved upon it the runes of his spirit - what an abundance of knowledge Wagner had to assemble and encompass to be able to become all that! And yet the weight of it as a whole did not stifle his will to action, nor did the attractions of its individual aspects entice him aside. To judge how uncommon such a posture is, one should compare it with that of its great counter-example, Goethe, who, as a learner and man of knowledge, appears like a many-branched river system which fails to sustain its full force as far as the sea but loses and scatters at least as much on its windings and meanderings as it bears on to its estuary. It is true that such a nature as Goethe's has and gives more enjoyment, something mild and nobly prodigal

hovers about it, whereas the violence of Wagner's current may terrify and scare one away. But let him who will be afraid: we others shall take courage from the sight of a hero who, even in regard to modern culture, 'has not learned fear'. * Just as little has he learned to let himself be placated by history and philosophy, to allow their softening and quietist effects to operate upon him. Neither the creative nor the embattled artist was deflected from his course by the force of what he had learned or the act of learning itself. As soon as his creative power takes hold on him history becomes malleable clay in his hands; his relationship towards it suddenly becomes quite different from that of any scholar, it becomes similar to that of the Greek towards his myths, that is to say towards something which offers material for plastic and poetic invention, performed with love and a certain shy devotion, to be sure, but nonetheless also with the magisterial right of the creator. And precisely because it is to him even more flexible and changeable than any dream, he can transform a single event into something that typifies whole ages and thus achieve a truth of representation such as the historian can never attain to. Where else has the courtly Middle Ages been transformed into a flesh-and-blood figure as it has in Lohengrin? And will the Meistersinger not speak of the German nature to all future ages - more, will it not constitute one of the ripest fruits of that nature, which always seeks reformation not revolution, and though broadly content with itself has not forgotten that noblest expression of discontent, the innovative deed? And it was to precisely this kind of discontent that Wagner was compelled again and again by his involvement with history and philosophy: he discovered here, not only weapons and armour, but also and above all the inspiring afflatus that wafts from the tombs of all great warriors, of all great sufferers and thinkers. One cannot stand out more clearly from the whole contemporary age than through the way one employs history and philosophy. The former, "A phrase from Siegfried. Richard Wagner in Bayreuth as it is commonly understood, now seems to have been assigned the task of letting modern man catch his breath as he runs panting and sweating towards his goal, so that for a moment he can feel as it were unharnessed. What the individual Montaigne signifies within the agitation of the spirit of the Reformation, a coming to rest within oneself, a peaceful being for oneself and relaxation - and that was certainly how his best reader, Shakespeare, experienced him - is what history is for the modern spirit. If the Gennans have for a century been especially devoted to the study of history, this shows that within the agitation of the contemporary world they represent the retarding, delaying, pacifying power: which some might perhaps turn into a commendation of them. On the whole, however, it is a dangerous sign when the spiritual struggles of a people are concerned principally with the past, a mark of debility, of regression and feebleness: so that it is exposed in the most dangerous fashion to every rampant fever going, the political fever for instance. In the history of the modern

spirit our scholars represent such a condition of weakness, in antithesis to all revolutionary and reform movements; the task they have set themselves is not the proudest, but they have secured for themselves a kind of peaceable happiness. Every freer, more manly step goes past them, to be sure - though by no means past history itself! The latter has quite different forces within it, a fact realized by precisely such natures as Wagner: only it has to be written in a much more serious, much stricter manner, out of a mighty soul and in general no longer optimistically, as it always has been hitherto; differently, that is to say, from how German scholars have written it up to now. There is something palliative, obsequious and contented about all their work, and they approve of the way things are. It is a great deal if one of them lets it be seen that he is contented only because things could have been worse: most of them involuntarily believe that the way things have turned out is very good. If history were not still a disguised Christian theodicy, if it were written with more justice and warmth of feeling, it would truly be of no use whatever for the purpose to which it is now put: to serve as an opiate for everything revolutionary and innovative. Philosophy is in a similar situation: all most people want to learn from it is a rough - very rough! - understanding of the world, so as then to accommodate themselves to the world. And even its noblest representatives emphasize so strongly its power to soothe and console that the indolent and those who long for rest must think they are seeking the same thing philosophy is seeking. To me, on the other hand, the most vital of questions for philosophy appears to be to what extent the character of the world is unalterable: so as, once this question has been answered, to set about improving that part only recognized as alterable with the most ruthless courage. True philosophers themselves teach this lesson, through the fact that they have worked to improve the very much alterable judgments of mankind and have not kept their wisdom to themselves; it is also taught by those true disciples of true philosophers who, like Wagner, know how to imbibe from them an enhanced resolution and inflexibility but no soporific juices. Wagner is most a philosopher when he is most energetic and heroic. And it was precisely as a philosopher that he passed through not only the fire of various philosophical systems without feeling fear, but also through the smoke of scholarly knowledge, and remained loyal to his higher self, which demanded of him deeds in which his manyfaceted nature participated as a whole and bade him suffer and learn so as to be capable of these deeds. b The history of the evolution of culture since the Greeks is short enough, if one takes into account the actual distance covered and ignores the halts, regressions, hesitations and lingerings. The Hellenization of the world and, to make this possible, the orientalizing of the Hellenic - the twofold task of the great Alexander is still the last great event; the old question whether a culture can be transplanted to a foreign soil at all is still the problem over which the moderns weary themselves. The rhythmic play against one another of these two

factors is what has especially determined the course of history hitherto. Here Christianity, for example, appears as a piece of oriental antiquity, thought and worked through by men with excessive thoroughness. As its influence has waned, the power of the Hellenic cultural world has again increased; we experience phenomena which are so peculiar they would hang in the air incomprehensible to us if we could not look back over a tremendous space of time and connect them with their Greek counterparts. Thus there are between Kant and the Eleatics, >:< Schopenhauer and Empedocles, Aeschylus and Richard Wagner such approximations and affinities #The Eleatics: the followers of the pre-Socratic philosopher Parmenides (born about 510 Bq. the first European metaphysician any of whose writings have survived. Richard Wagner in Bayreuth that one is reminded almost palpably of the very relative nature of all concepts of time: it almost seems as though many things belong together and time is only a cloud which makes it hard for our eyes to perceive the fact. The history of the exact sciences especially evokes the impression that we even now stand in the closest proximity to the Alexandrian-Hellenic world and that the pendulum of history has swung back to the point from which it started its swing into enigmatic distant and lost horizons. The picture presented by our contemporary world is certainly not a novel one: to him who knows history it must seem more and more as though he were recognizing the old familiar features of a face. The spirit of Hellenic culture lies endlessly dispersed over our present-day world: while forces of all kinds crowd forth and the fruits of the modern sciences and accomplishments are bartered, the pale features of the Hellenic appear ghostlike in the distance. The earth, which has now been sufficiently orientalized, longs again for the Hellenic; he who wants to assist here has need of speed and a winged foot, to be sure, if he is to bring together all the manifold disseminated points of knowledge, the remotest continents of talent, to run through and command the whole tremendous region. Thus it is that we now have need of a series of counter-Alexanders possessing the mighty capacity to draw together and unite, to reach the remotest threads and to preserve the web from being blown away. Not to cut the Gordian knot, as Alexander did, so that its ends fluttered to all the corners of the earth, but to tie it again - that is now the task. I recognize in Wagner such a counter Alexander: he unites what was separate, feeble and inactive; if a medicinal expression is permitted, he possesses an astringent power: to this extent he is one of the truly great cultural masters. He is master of the arts, the religions, the histories of the various nations, yet he is the opposite of a polyhistor, a spirit who only brings together and arranges: for he is one who unites what he has brought together into a living structure, a simplifier of the world. One will not misunderstand such an idea if one compares this most general task set for him by his genius with the much narrower one which the name of Wagner usually calls to mind. What is expected of him is a

reform of the theatre: supposing he achieved it, what would thereby have been accomplished for that higher and remoter task? Certainly modern man would have been altered and reformed: everything in our modern world is so dependent on everything else that to remove a single nail is to make the whole building tremble and collapse. This may seem an exaggerated thing to say of the Wagnerian reform, yet any real reform could be expected to lead to a similar result. It is quite impossible to produce the highest and purest effect of which the art of the theatre is capable without at the same time effecting innovations everywhere, in morality and politics, in education and society. Love and justice grown mighty in one domain, in this instance that of art, must in accordance with the law of their inner compulsion extend themselves into other domains and cannot return to the inert condition of their former chrysalis stage. Even to grasp the extent to which the relationship of our arts to life is a symbol of the degeneration of this life, the extent to which our theatre is a disgrace to those who maintain and frequent it, one has to adopt a completely new viewpoint and be able for once to regard the commonplace and everyday as something very uncommon and complex. Strangely clouded judgment, ill-dissembled thirst for amusement, for distraction at any cost, scholarly considerations, pomposity and affectation on the part of the performers, brutal greed for money on that of the proprietors, vacuity and thoughtlessness on that of a society which thinks of the people only insofar as it is employable or dangerous to it and attends concerts and the theatre without any notion of possessing a duty towards them all this together constitutes the musty corrupted air of our world of art today: but if one is as accustomed to it as our cultivated people are, one no doubt believes it necessary for one's health and feels ill if deprived of it for any length of time. There is really only one short way of convincing oneself of how vulgar, how peculiarly and oddly vulgar, our theatrical institutions are, and that is to compare them with the former reality of the Greek theatre. If we knew nothing of the Greeks, then the conditions that now obtain would perhaps be unavoidable and the kind of objections first raised in the grand manner by Wagner would be regarded as the dreams of dwellers in the land of nowhere. The way people are, it might perhaps be said, the kind of art we have is satisfactory and suited to them - and they have never been any different! - But they most certainly have been different, and even now there are people who are not satisfied with our present institutions - as the fact of Bayreuth itself demonstrates. Here you will discover spectators prepared and dedicated, people with the feeling of being at the summit of their happiness and that their whole nature is being pulled together for yet higher and wider endeavours; here you will discover the most devoted self-sacrifice on the part of the artists and, the spectacle of all spectacles, the victorious creator of a work which is itself the epitome of an abundance Richard Wagner in Bayreuth of victorious artistic deeds. Must it not seem almost like

magic to encounter such a phenomenon in the world of today? Must not those who are permitted to participate in it not be transformed and renewed, so as henceforth to transform and renew in other domains of life? Has a harbour not been reached after the desert expanse of the sea, does a stillness not lie over the water here? - When he who . has experienced the profound and solitary mood which reigns here returns to the shallows and lowlands of life, must he not ask with Isolde: 'How could I have endured it? How do I endure it now?' * And if he cannot endure to keep his happiness and unhappiness selfishly to himself, he will henceforth seize every opportunity to bear witness through his actions. Where are those who suffer on account of the institutions of the present? he will ask. Where are our natural allies, together with whom we can fight against the rampant aggression of contemporary bogus culture? For at present - at present! - we have only one enemy, those 'cultivated people' for whom the word 'Bayreuth' signifies one of their most shattering defeats - they rendered no assistance, they raged against it, or they exhibited that even more effective hardness-of-hearing which has now become a customary weapon of refined opposition. But the fact that their enmity and malice was incapable of destroying Wagner or of hindering his work teaches us one more thing: it betrays that they are weak and that the resistance of the former rulers will no longer be able to withstand many more attacks. The time has come for those who want conquest and victory, the greatest domains lie open, and wherever there are possessions a question-mark is set against the name of the possessor. Thus the structure of education, for example, has been recognized as rotten, and everywhere there are those who have already silently quitted it. If only those who are already in fact profoundly disaffected could be incited to a public declaration and to public indignation! If only they could be roused out of their de spairing despondency! I know that if one were to deduct what these natures contribute to the proceeds of our whole system of culture, the latter would be subjected to the most enfeebling blood-letting imaginable. Of the scholars, for example, only those infected with the political mania and the literary scribblers of all kinds would be left behind under the old regime. The repellent structure which now derives its strength from the spheres of power and injustice, from the state and society, and sees its advantage in rendering the latter ever *From Tristan und Isolde. 21 1 more evil and ruthless, would without it be something feeble and weary: at the first sign of open contempt it would collapse. He who fights for love and justice between men has least to fear from it: for it is only when he has come to the end of the struggle he is now waging against their advanced guard, the culture of today, that he will encounter his real enemies. To us, Bayreuth signifies the morning consecration on the day of battle. We could not be done a greater injustice than if it were assumed we were concerned only with art: as though it were a kind of cure and intoxicant with the aid of which one could rid oneself of every other sickness.

What we see depicted in the tragic art-work of Bayreuth is the struggle of the individual against everything that opposes him as apparently invincible necessity, with power, law, tradition, compact and the whole prevailing order of things. The individual cannot live more fairly than in being prepared to die in the struggle for love and justice and in sacrificing himself to it. The glance with which the mysterious eye of tragedy gazes upon us is no sorcery that prostrates us and paralyses (jUr limbs. Even though it demands that we be quiet so long as it is gazing upon us - for art does not exist for the struggle itself, but for the intervals of quiet before and in the midst of it, for those moments when, glancing behind and looking ahead, we comprehend the symbolic, when feelings of tired ness which overcome us are attended by a refreshing dream. Day and the battle dawn together, the sacred shadows disperse and art is again far distant from us; but its morning consolation lies upon us still. For the individual discovers everywhere else nothing but what is personally dissatisfying and impervious to him: how could he fight with any kind of courage if he had not first been consecrated to something higher than his own person! The greatest causes of suffering there are for the individual - that men do not share all knowledge in common, that ultimate insight can never be certain, that abilities are divided unequally - all this puts him in need of art. We cannot be happy so long as everything around us suffers and creates suffering; we cannot be moral so long as the course of human affairs is deter mined by force, deception and injustice; we cannot even be wise so long as the whole of mankind has not struggled in competition for wisdom and conducted the individual into life and knowledge in the . way dictated by wisdom. How could we endure to live in the feeling of this threefold incapacity if we were unable to recognize in our struggles, striving and failures something sublime and significant and did not learn from tragedy to take delight in the rhythm of grand passion and in its victim. Art is, to be sure, no instructor or educator 2 1 2 Richard Wagner in Bayreuth in direct action; the artist is never an educator or counsellor in this sense; the objectives for which the tragic hero strives are not without further ado the things worth striving for per se. Our evaluation of things so long as we are firmly under the spell of art is different, as it is in a dream: that which, while the spell lasts, we consider so much worth striving for that we ally ourselves with the hero when he pre fers to die rather than renounce it - in real life this is seldom of the same value or worthy of the same degree of effort: that is precisely why art is the activity of man in repose. The struggles it depicts are simplifications of the real struggles oflife; its problems are abbrevi ations of the endlessly complex calculus of human action and desire. But the greatness and indispensability of art lie precisely in its being able to produce the appearance of a simpler world, a shorter solution of the riddle oflife. No one who suffers from life can do without this appearance, just as no one can do without sleep. The harder it becomes to know the laws of life, the

more ardently do we long for this appearance of simplification, even if only for moments, the greater grows the tension between general knowledge of things and the individual's spiritual-moral capacities. Art exists so that the bow shall not break. The individual must be consecrated to something higher than himself - that is the meaning of tragedy; he must be free of the terrible anxiety which death and time evoke in the individual: for at any moment, in the briefest atom of his life's course, he may encounter something holy that endlessly outweighs all his struggle and all his distress - this is what it means to have a sense for the tragic; all the ennoblement of mankind is enclosed in this. supreme task; the definite rejection of this task would be the saddest picture imaginable to a friend of man. That is my view of things! There is only one hope and one guarantee for the future of humanity: it consists in his retention of the sense for the tragic. An unheard-of cry of distress would resound across the earth if mankind should ever lose it completely; and, conversely, there is no more rapturous joy than to know what we know - that the tragic idea has again been born into the world. For this joy is altogether universal and suprapersonal, the rejoicing of mankind at the guarantee of the unity and continuance of the human as such. Wagner subjected the life of the present and the past to the illumination of an insight strong enough to penetrate to uncommonly remote regions: that is why he can be called a simplifier of the world, for simplification of the world consists in being able to view and thus master the tremendous abundance of an apparently chaotic wilderness and to bring together in unity that which was formerly thought to be set irreconcilably asunder. Wagner did this by discovering a relationship between two things which appeared to be completely alien to one another as though they dwelt in different spheres: between music and life, and likewise between music and drama. He did not invent or create these relationships: they are there, lying in everybody's path, just as every great problem is like the precious stone which thousands walk over before one finally picks it up. What does it signify, Wagner asked himself, that precisely such an art as music should have arisen with such incomparable force in the life of modern man? It is not at all necessary to have a low opinion of this life in order to perceive a problem here; no, when one considers all the great forces pertaining to this life and pictures to oneself an existence striving mightily upwards and struggling for conscious freedom and independence of thought - only then does music appear truly an enigma in this world. Must one not say that music could not arise out of this age! But what then is the meaning of its existence? Is it a chance event? A single great artist might be a chance event, certainly; but the appearance of a series of great artists such as the history of modern music discloses - a series equalled only once before, in the age of the Greeks - makes one think it is not chance but necessity that rules here. This necessity is precisely the problem to which Wagner furnishes an answer. First of all he recognized a state of distress extending as far as civilization now

unites nations: everywhere language is sick, and the oppression of this tremendous sickness weighs on the whole of human development. Inasmuch as language has had continually to climb up to the highest rung of achievement possible to it so as to encompass the realm of thought - a realm diametrically opposed to that for the expression of which it was originally supremely adapted, namely the realm of strong feelings it has during the brief period of contemporary civilization become exhausted through this excessive effort: so that now it is no longer capable of performing that function for the sake of which alone it exists: to enable suffering mankind to come to an understanding with one another over the simplest needs of life. Man can no longer express his needs and distress by means of language, thus he can no longer really communicate at all: and under these dimly perceived conditions language has everywhere

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Richard Wagner in Bayreuth become a power in its own right which now embraces mankind with ghostly arms and impels it to where it does not really want to go. As soon as men seek to come to an understanding with one another, and to unite for a common work, they are seized by the madness of universal concepts, indeed even by the mere sounds of words, and, as a consequence of this incapacity to communicate, everything they do together bears the mark of this lack of mutual understanding, inasmuch as it does not correspond to their real needs but only to the hollowness of those tyrannical words and concepts: thus to all its other sufferings mankind adds suffering from convention, that is to say from a mutual agreement as to words and actions without a mutual agreement as to feelings. Just as when every art goes into decline a point is reached at which its morbidly luxuriant forms and techniques gain a tyrannical domination over the souls of youthful artists and make them their slaves, so with the decline of language we are the slaves of words; under this constraint no one is any longer capable of revealing himself, of speaking naively, and few are capable of preserving their individuality at all in the face of an education which believes it demonstrates its success, not in going out to meet clear needs and feelings in an educative sense, but in entangling the individual in the net of 'clear concepts' and teaching him to think correctly: as if there were any sense whatever in making of a man a being who thinks - and concludes correctly if one has not first succeeded in making of him one who feels rightly. Now when the music of our German masters resounds in the ears of mankind injured to this extent, what is it really that here becomes audible? Precisely this right feeling, the enemy of all convention, all artificial alienation and incomprehension between man and man: this music is a return to nature, while being at the same time the purification and transformation of nature; for the pressing need for that return to nature arose in the souls of men filled with love, and in their art there sounds nature transformed - in love: Let us take this to be one of Wagner's answers to the question as to what music signifies in our time: he also has a second. The

relationship between music and life is not only that of one kind of language to another kind of language, it is also the relationship between the perfect world of sound and the totality of the world of sight. Regarded as a phenomenon for the eyes, however, and compared with the phenomena of life of earlier times, the existence of modern men exhibits an unspeakable poverty and exhaustion, despite the unspeakable gaudiness which can give pleasure only to the most superficial glance. If one looks a little more closely and analyses the impression made by this vigorously agitated play of colours, does the whole not appear as the glitter and sparkle of countless little stones and fragments borrowed from earlier cultures? Is everything here not inappropriate pomp, imitated activity, presumptuous superficiality? A suit of gaudy patches for the naked and freezing? A dance of seeming joy exacted from sufferers? An air of haughty pride worn by one wounded to the depths? And amid it all, concealed and dissembled only by the rapidity of the movement and confusion, hoary impotence, nagging discontent, industrious boredom, dishonourable wretchedness! The phenomenon of modern man has become wholly appearance; he is not visible in what he represents but rather concealed by it; and the remnant of artistic inventiveness retained by a nation, by the French and Italians for instance, is employed in this art of concealment. Wherever 'form' is nowadays demanded, in society and in conversation, in literary expression, in traffic between states, what is involuntarily understood by it is a pleasing appearance, the antithesis of the true concept of form as shape necessitated by content, which has nothing to do with 'pleasing' or 'displeasing' precisely because it is necessary and not arbitrary. But even in civilized nations where this form is not expressly demanded, that necessary shape which is true form is just as little in evidence: it is only that the striving after a pleasing appearance has been less successful, even though pursued with at least as much zeal. For how pleasing the appearance is, in the one case or the other, and why it must be agreeable to everyone that modern man at least makes an effort at an appearance, each will decide to the degree to which he himself is a modern man. 'Only galley-slaves understand one another', says Tasso, 'but we politely misunderstand others so that they shall misunderstand us in return.' * In this world of forms and desired misunderstanding there now appear souls filled with music - to what purpose? In noble honesty, in a passion that is suprapersonal, they move to a grand, free rhythm, they glow with the mighty tranquil fire of the music that wells up out of inexhaustible depths within them - all this to what purpose? Through these souls music reaches out to its corresponding necessary shape in the world of the visible, that is to say, to its form. In Goethe's *Torquato Tasso*, Act 5 Scene 5 (the italicizing of 'misunderstand' is Nietzsche's). 2.1.6 Richard Wagner in *Bayreuth sister*, gymnastics: in its search for this it becomes judge over the whole visible world of the present. This is Wagner's second answer to the question as to what significance music can have

in this age. Help me, he cries to all who can hear, help me to discover that culture whose existence my music, as the rediscovered language of true feeling, prophesies; reflect that the soul of music now wants to create for itself a body, that it seeks its path through all of you to visibility in movement, deed, structure and morality! There are men who comprehend this call, and there will be more and more of them; and they have also for the first time grasped anew what it means to found the state upon music, something the ancient Hellenes not only grasped but also demanded of themselves: whereas they would condemn the contemporary state as unconditionally as most men now condemn the church. The path to so new yet not wholly unheard-of a goal leads to an admission to ourselves that the most shameful shortcoming of our education and the actual ground of its inability to emerge from barbarism is its lack of the enlivening and formative soul of music, and that its demands and institutions are products of a time when the music from which we expect so much had not yet been born. Our education is the most backward structure of the present day, and it is backward precisely in regard to the only new educative force which contemporary mankind has that previous centuries did not have - or which they could have if they would cease their mindless scurrying forward under the lash of the moment! Because they have up to now not let the soul of music lodge within them, they have as yet no inkling of gymnastics in the Greek and Wagnerian sense of the word; and this is again the reason their plastic artists are condemned to hopelessness so long as they continue to desire to dispense with music to conduct them into a new visible world: it does not matter how much talent they have, it will come either too late or too soon and in any case at the wrong time, for it is superfluous and ineffective, since the perfect and highest products of former ages, the pattern for our contemporary artists, are themselves superfluous and almost ineffective and hardly capable now of setting one stone upon another. If they behold within themselves no new figures before them but only the old figures behind them, then they may serve history but they cannot serve life, and they are dead while they are still breathing: the one who feels true, fruitful life within him, however - and at present that means music - could he be misled for a moment into expecting anything further from something that exhausts itself in figures, forms and styles? He has gone beyond all vanities of this sort; and he thinks of discovering artistic wonders outside his ideal world of sound as little as he expects great writers still to emerge from our exhausted and colourless languages. Rather than giving ear to any kind of vain consolation, he can endure to direct his profoundly dissatisfied gaze upon our modern world: let him become full of bitterness and hatred if his heart is not warm enough for pity! Even malice and mockery is better than that he should, in the manner of our 'friends of art', give himself over to fraudulent self contentment and quiet dipsomania! But even if he can do more than deny and mock, if he can love, pity and assist, he must

nonetheless at first deny, so as to create a pathway for his helpful soul. If music is one day to move many men to piety for music and to acquaint them with its highest objectives, an end must first be made to all pleasure seeking traffic with so sacred an art; the foundation upon which our artistic entertainments, theatre, museums, concert societies rest, namely the aforesaid 'friend of art', must be placed under an interdict; the public judgment which lays such peculiar stress on cultivating this species of friendship for art must be l>eaten from the field by a better judgment. In the meantime we must count even the declared enemy of art as a real and useful ally, since that of which he has declared himself an enemy is precisely art as the 'friend of art' understands it: for he knows no other! Let him by all means call the friend of art to account for the senseless squandering of money on the construction of his theatres and public monuments, the engagement of his 'celebrated' singers and actors, the maintenance of his wholly unproductive art-schools and picture-galleries: not to speak . of all the effort, time and money thrown away in every household on instruction in supposed 'artistic pursuits'. Here there is no hunger and no satiety, but only an insipid pretence of both designed to mislead the judgment of others; or, even worse, if art is taken relatively seriously one demands of it the engendering of hunger and desire and discovers its task to lie precisely in this artificially engendered excitement. As though one feared perishing through one's own self disgust and dullness, one calls up every evil demon so as to be driven like a deer by these hunters: one thirsts for suffering, anger, passion, sudden terror, breathless tension, and calls upon the artist as the one who can conjure up this spectral chase. Within the spiritual . "household of our cultivated people art is now a wholly spurious or a shameful, ignominious need, either nothing or something malign. The better and rarer kind of artist is as though caught up in a bewildering dream so as not to see all this, and he hesitantly repeats 2 1 8 Richard Wagner in Bayreuth in an uncertain tone ghostly words he thinks he hears coming from far away but cannot quite grasp; the artist of the modern stamp, on the other hand, is full of contempt for the dreamy groping of his nobler colleague and leads the whole brawling crowd of passions and abominations after him on a string so as to let them loose on modern men when required: for the latter would rather be hunted, injured and torn to pieces than have to live quietly alone with themselves. Alone with themselves! - the idea of this makes modern souls quake, it is their kind of terror and fear of ghosts. When in populous cities I watch the thousands pass by and behold their gloomy or harried expressions, I tell myself repeatedly that they must be feeling unwell. But for all these people art exists merely so that they shall feel even more unwell, even gloomier and more senseless, or even more harried and greedy. For they are unremittingly ridden and drilled by false feeling, which in this way prevents them from admitting to themselves how wretched they are; if they want to speak, convention whispers

something into their ear which makes them forget what it was they really wanted to say; if they want to come to an understanding with one another, their own understanding is paralysed as though by a spell, so that what they call happiness is really their misfortune and they wilfully collaborate together to advance their own adversity. Thus they are wholly transformed and reduced to the helpless slaves of false feeling. Here are two examples to demonstrate how perverse the sensibilities of our age have become and how the age has no perception of this perversity. In former times one looked down with honest nobility on people who dealt in money as a business, even though one had need of them; one admitted to oneself that every society had to have interests. Now, as the most covetous of its regions, they are the ruling power in the soul of modern humanity. In former times there was nothing one was warned against more than against taking the day, the moment, too seriously; one was urged *nil admirari* and to be concerned with matters of eternity; now only one kind of seriousness still remains in the modern soul, that directed towards the news brought by the newspapers or the telegraph. To employ the moment and, so as to profit from it, to assess its value as quickly as possible! - one might believe that modern man has retained only one of the virtues, that of presence of mind. Unhappily, it is in truth more like the 219 omnipresence of a dirty, insatiable greed and a prying curiosity. Whether mind is now present at all - we shall leave that question to the judges of the future who will one day put modern man through their sieve. But that this age is vulgar can be seen already, for it holds in honour that which former noble ages despised; and if it has appropriated to itself all that is valuable in the art and wisdom of the past and promenades around in this most opulent of all raiment, it shows an uncanny awareness of its vulgarity in that it employs this cloak not to keep itself warm, but only to disguise itself. The need to dissemble and to conceal itself seems more pressing than the need not to be cold. Thus our contemporary scholars and philosophers do not employ the wisdom of the Indians and the Greeks so as to grow wise and calm within themselves: the sole purpose of their work is to create for the present day an illusory reputation for wisdom. Students of animal behaviour exert themselves to represent the bestial outbreaks of violence and cunning and revengefulness in the mutual relations between contemporary states and men as unalterable laws of nature. Historians are engaged with inxious assiduity in proving the proposition that every age possesses rights of its own and its own conditions of existence - this by way of preparing the basis of the defence to be presented at the court proceedings which will be visited upon our age. Theories of the state, of the nation, of the economy, trade, justice - they all now have the character of a preparatory apologia; it seems, indeed, as though the only task of all active spirit not used up in propelling the great economy- and power- machine is the defence and exculpation of the present. Before what accuser? one asks in perplexity. Before

its own bad conscience. And the task of modern art, too, suddenly becomes clear: stupefaction or delirium! To put to sleep or to intoxicate! To silence the conscience, by one means or the other! To help the modern soul to forget its feeling of guilt, not to help it to return to innocence! And this at least for moments at a time! To defend man against himself by compelling him to silence and to an inability to hear! - the few who have felt what this most shameful of tasks, this dreadful degradation of art, really means will find their souls filling to the brim with regret and pity: but also with a new mighty longing. He who desired to liberate art, to restore its desecrated sanctity, would first have to have liberated himself from the modern soul; only when innocent himself could he discover the innocence of art, and he thus has two tremendous acts of purification and consecration to accomplish. If Richard Wagner in Bayreuth he were victorious, if he spoke to men out of his liberated soul in the language of his liberated art, only then would he encounter his greatest danger and his most tremendous battle; men would rather tear him and his art to pieces than admit they must perish for shame in the face of them. It is possible that the redemption of art, the only gleam of light to be hoped for in the modern age, will be an event reserved to only a couple of solitary souls, while the many continue to gaze into the flickering and smoky fire of their art: for they do not want light, they want bedazzlement; they hate light - when it is thrown upon themselves. Thus they avoid the new bringer of light; but, constrained by the love out of which he was born, he pursues them and wants to constrain them. 'You shall pass through my mysteries', he cries to them, 'you need their purifications and convulsions. Risk it for the sake of your salvation and desert for once the dimly lit piece of nature and life which is all you seem to know; I lead you into a realm that is just as real, you yourselves shall say when you emerge out of my cave into your daylight which life is more real, which is really daylight and which cave. Nature is in its depths much richer, mightier, happier, more dreadful; in the way you usually live you do not know it: learn to become nature again yourselves and then with and in nature let yourselves be transformed by the magic of my love and fire.' It is the voice of Wagner's art which speaks thus to mankind. That we children of a wretched age were permitted to be the first to hear it shows how worthy of pity precisely our age must be, and shows in general that true music is a piece of fate and primal law; for it is impossible to derive its appearance at precisely this time from an empty, meaningless act of chance; a Wagner who appeared by chance would have been crushed by the superior force of the opposing element into which he was thrown. But there lies over the evolution of the real Wagner a transfiguring and justifying necessity. To behold his art coming into existence is to behold a glorious spectacle, notwithstanding the suffering that attended it, for reason, law, purpose are evident everywhere. In his joy at this spectacle, the beholder will laud this suffering itself and reflect with delight on how primordially determined

nature and giftedness must turn everything to prosperity and gain no matter how hard the school it has to pass through; how every kind of peril makes it bolder and every victory more thoughtful; how it feeds on poison and misfortune and grows strong and healthy in the process. Mockery and contradiction by the world around it are a goad and a stimulus; if it wanders into error, it returns home with the most marvellous booty; if it sleeps, 'its sleep only gives it new strength'. * It even steals the body and makes it more robust; it does not consume life however long it lives; it rules over man like a winged passion and at the moment his foot has grown weary in the sand or is hurt against a stone it lifts him into the air. It can do nothing other than communicate, everyone is to collaborate in its work, it is not niggardly with its gifts. If it is repulsed, it gives more abundantly; if the recipient misuses it, it adds to its gifts the most precious jewel it possesses - and the oldest and most recent experience teaches that the recipients have never been quite worthy of the gift. Primordially determined nature through which music speaks to the world of appearance is thus the most enigmatic thing under the sun, an abyss in which force and goodness dwell together, a bridge between the self and the non-self. Who can, clearly name the purpose for which it exists at all, even though it may be apparent that purposiveness exists in the way it came into being? But the happiest presentiment may permit us to ask: should the greater exist for the sake of the less, the greatest giftedness for the good of the smallest, the highest virtue and holiness for the sake of frailty? Did true music not resound because mankind deserved it least but needed it most? If we let ourselves ponder the boundless miracle of this possibility and then, out of this reflection, look back on life, we shall see all flooded in light, however dark and misty it may have seemed before. Nothing else is possible: he before whom there stands such a nature as Wagner's is from time to time compelled to reflect upon himself, upon his own pettiness and frailty, and to ask himself: what would this nature have with you? to what end do you really exist? - Probably he will be unable to find an answer, and will then stand perplexed at his own being. Let him then be satisfied to have experienced even this; let him hear in the fact that he feels alienated from his own being the answer to his question. For it is with precisely this feeling that he participates in Wagner's mightiest accomplishment, the central point of his power, the demonic transmissibility and self-relinquishment of his nature, with which others are able to communicate just as readily as it communicates with other natures, and whose greatness consists in * From Hans Sachs's monologue in Act III of *Meistersinger*. " · r Richard Wagner in Bayreuth its capacity both to surrender and to receive. By apparently succumbing to Wagner's overflowing nature, he who reflects upon it has in fact participated in its energy and has thus as it were through him acquired power against him; and whoever examines himself closely knows that even mere contemplation involves a secret antagonism, the antagonism involved in

comparison. If his art allows us to experience all that a soul encounters when it goes on a journey - participation in other souls and their destiny, acquisition of the ability to look at the world through many eyes - we are then, through knowledge of such strange and remote things, also made capable of seeing him himself after having experienced him himself. Then we feel certain that in Wagner all that is visible in the world wants to become more profound and more intense by becoming audible, that it seeks here its lost soul; and that all that is audible in the world likewise wants to emerge into the light and also become a phenomenon for the eye; that it wants as it were to acquire corporeality. His art always conducts him along this twofold path, from a world as an audible spectacle into a world as a visible spectacle enigmatically related to it, and the reverse; he is continually compelled - and the beholder is compelled with him - to translate visible movement back into soul and primordial life, and conversely to see the most deeply concealed inner activity as visible phenomenon and to clothe it with the appearance of a body. All this constitutes the essence of the dithyrambic dramatist, this concept extended to embrace at once the actor, poet and composer: as it must be, since it is necessarily derived from the only perfect exemplar of the dithyrambic dramatist before Wagner, from Aeschylus and his fellow Greek artists. If one has tried to see the evolution of the greatest artists as deriving from inner constraints or lacunae; if, for example, poetry was for Goethe a kind of substitute for a failed calling as a painter; if one can speak of Schiller's plays as being vulgar eloquence redirected; if Wagner himself seeks to interpret the promotion of music by the Germans by supposing among other things that, denied the seductive stimulus of a naturally melodious voice, they were compelled to take the art of music with something of the same degree of seriousness as their religious reformers took Christianity -: so, if one wanted in a similar way to associate Wagner's evolution with such an inner constraint, one might assume the existence in him of an original histrionic talent which had to deny itself satisfaction by the most obvious and trivial route and which found its expedient and deliverance in drawing together all the arts into a great histrionic manifestation. But then one would also have to be allowed to say that the mightiest musical natures, in despair at having to speak to the semi- or non-musical, violently forced entry to the other arts so as finally to communicate themselves with hundredfold clarity and compel the people to understand them. But, however one may picture the evolution of the potential dramatist, in his perfect maturity he is a figure without any kind of constraint or lacunae: the actually free artist who can do nothing other than think in all the arts at once, the mediator between and reconciler of spheres apparently divided from one another, the restorer of a unity and totality to the artistic faculty which can in no way be divined or arrived at by reasoning, but only demonstrated through a practical deed. He before whom this deed is suddenly performed, however, will be

overpowered by it as by the uncanniest, most magnetic magic: all at once he stands before a power which makes all resistance senseless, which indeed seems to rob all one's previous life of sense and comprehensibility: in an ecstasy, we swim in an enigmatic, fiery element, we no longer know ourself, no longer recognize the most familiar things; we no longer possess any standard of measurement, everything fixed and rigid begins to grow fluid, everything shines in novel colours, speaks to us in new signs and symbols: - now, involved in this mixture of joy and fear, one would have to be Plato to be able to resolve as he did and to say to the dramatist: 'if a man who, by virtue of his wisdom could become all possible things and imitate all things, should enter our community, let us revere him as something miraculous and holy, anoint his head with oil and set a wreath upon it, but then try to persuade him to go away to another community'. It may be that one living in the Platonic community can and must persuade himself to such a thing: all we others, who live in no such community but in communities constituted quite differently, desire and demand that the sorcerer should come to us, even though we may fear him - in order that our community and the false reason and power whose embodiment it is should for once be denied. A condition of man kind, of its communities, moralities, societies, institutions as a whole, which could do without the imitative artist is perhaps not a complete impossibility, but this 'perhaps' is one of the boldest there is and amounts to the same thing as a 'very improbably'; only he should be permitted to speak of it who could anticipate and realize in his mind the supreme moment of all time yet to come and then, like Faust, had to grow blind - had to and had a right to, for we have no right even to this blindness, whereas Plato for example, after having Richard Wagner in Bayreuth cast a single glance into the Hellenic ideal, had the right to be blind to Hellenic reality. We others, on the contrary, need art precisely because we have evolved looking into the face of reality; and we need precisely the universal dramatist so that he may, for a few hours at least, redeem us from the fearful tension which the seeing man now feels between himself and the tasks imposed upon him. With him we ascend to the topmost rung of sensibility and only there do we fancy we have returned to free nature and the realm of freedom; from this height we behold, as though in immense air-drawn reflections, our struggles, victories and defeats as something sublime and significant; we have delight in the rhythm of passion and in its victim, with every mighty step the hero takes we hear the dull echo of death and in its proximity we sense the supreme stimulus to life: thus transformed into tragic men we return to life in a strangely consoled mood, with a new feeling of security, as though out of supreme dangers, excesses, ecstasies, we had found our way back to the limited and familiar: back to where we are now abundantly benevolent and in any event nobler than we were before; for every thing that here appears serious and distressful, as progress towards a goal, is now, by

comparison with the path we ourselves have traversed, even if only in a dream, more like strangely isolated fragments of that total experience of which we have a terrified recollection; indeed, we shall run into danger, and be tempted to take life too easily, precisely because we have taken art so uncommonly seriously to allude to an expression with which Wagner characterized the course of his own life. For if we, who can only experience this art of the dithyrambic dramatist, not create it, find the dream almost more real than waking actuality, how must the creator of it evaluate this antithesis! There he stands in the midst of all the noisy summonses and importunities of the day, of the necessities of life, of society, of the state - as what? Perhaps as though he were the only one awake, the only one aware of the real and true, among confused and tormented sleepers, among sufferers deluded by fancy; some times no doubt he even feels as though a victim of a protracted sleeplessness, as though condemned to pass a clear and conscious life in the company of sleepwalkers and creatures of a spectral earnestness: so that all that seems everyday to others to him appears uncanny, and he feels tempted to counter the impression produced by this phenomenon with exuberant mockery. But this sensation becomes a peculiar hybrid, when to the brightness of this exuberance there is joined a quite different impulse, the longing to descend from the heights into the depths, the living desire for the earth, for the joy of communion - then, when he recalls all he is deprived of as a solitary creator, the longing at once to take all that is weak, human and lost and, like a god come to earth, 'raise it to Heaven in fiery arms', so as at last to find love and no longer only worship, and in love to relinquish himself utterly! The hybrid sensation assumed here is, however, the actual miracle in the soul of the dithyrambic dramatist; and if his nature can be conceptualized anywhere, it must be here. For the creative moments in his art are produced by the tension occasioned by this hybrid, when the uncanny and exuberant sensation of surprise and amazement at the world is coupled with the ardent longing to approach this same world as a lover. Whatever glances he may then cast upon earth and life, they are always beams of sunlight which 'suck up moisture', congregate mist, spread thunderclouds. His glance falls at once clear sighted and lovingly selfless: and everything he now illuminates with the twofold light of this glance is at once compelled by nature to discharge all its forces with fearful rapidity in a revelation of its most deeply hidden secrets: and it does so out of shame. It is more than a figure of speech to say that with this glance he has surprised nature, that he has seen her naked: so that now she seeks to conceal her shame by fleeing into her antitheses. What has hitherto been invisible and inward escapes into the sphere of the visible and becomes appearance; what was hitherto only visible flees into the dark ocean of the audible: thus, by seeking to hide herself; nature reveals the character of her antitheses. In an impetuously rhythmic yet hovering dance, in ecstatic gestures, the primordial dramatist speaks of what is now

coming to pass within him and within nature: the dithyramb of his dance is as much dread understanding and exuberant insight as it is a loving approach and joyful self-renunciation. Intoxicated, the word follows in the train of this rhythm; coupled with the word there sounds the melody; and melody in turn showers its fire into the realm of images and concepts. A dream apparition, like and unlike the image of nature and her wooer, floats by, it condenses into more human forms, it expands as the expression of a wholly heroic exuberant will, of an ecstatic going-under and cessation of will: - thus does tragedy come into being, thus there is bestowed upon life its most glorious form of wisdom, that of the tragic idea, thus there is at last arose the greatest sorcerer and benefactor of mortals, the dithyrambic dramatist. - Richard Wagner in Bayreuth Wagner's actual life, that is to say the gradual revelation of the dithyrambic dramatist, was at the same time an unceasing struggle with himself insofar as he was not only a dithyrambic dramatist: his struggle with the world which resisted him was so furious and uncanny because he heard this 'world', this bewitching enemy, speaking out of his own being and because he harboured within himself a mighty demon of resistance. When the ruling idea of his life - the idea that an incomparable amount of influence, the greatest influence of all the arts, could be exercised through the theatre - seized hold on him, it threw his being into the most violent ferment. It did not produce an immediate clear decision as to his future actions and objective; this idea appeared at first almost as a temptation, as an expression of his obscure personal will, which longed insatiably for power and fame. Influence, incomparable influence - how? over whom? - that was from now on the question and quest that ceaselessly occupied his head and heart. He wanted to conquer and rule as no artist had done before, and if possible to attain with a single blow that tyrannical omnipotence for which his instincts obscurely craved. With a jealous, deeply probing glance he scanned everything that enjoyed success, he observed even more those upon whom influence had to be exerted. Through the magical eye of the dramatist, who can read souls as easily as he can the most familiar writing, he saw to the bottom of the spectators and listeners, and though he was often disturbed by what he learned he nonetheless reached at once for the means of mastering it. These means were always available to him; what produced a strong effect upon him he was able himself to produce; of his models he understood at every stage just as much as he was himself able to create, and he never doubted that he could do whatever he wanted to. In this he is perhaps an even more 'presumptuous' nature than Goethe, who said of himself: 'I always believed I had everything; they could have set a crown upon my head and I would have thought it quite in order.' Wagner's ability and his 'taste' and likewise his. objective - these have at all times corresponded as closely to one another as a key does to a lock: - together they became great and free but they were not so at first. What to him were the feeble, noble yet selfishly solitary

sensations experienced far from the great crowd by this or that friend of art educated in literature and aesthetically refined? But those violent storms of the soul produced by the great crowd when dramatic song rises in intensity, that sudden explosive intoxication of spirit, honest through and through and selfless - that was the echo of his own feeling and experience, and when he heard it he was permeated with a glowing anticipation of supreme power and influence! Thus it was he came to understand that grand opera was the means through which he could give expression to his ruling idea; his desire drew him towards it, his eyes turned in the direction of its home. A long period of his life, together with the daring changes and alterations his plans, studies, places of residence, acquaintanceships underwent, are explicable only by reference to this desire and to the external resistance the needy, restless, passionately naive German artist was bound to encounter. Another artist understood better how to become master in this domain; and now it has gradually become known with what an intricate web of influences of every kind Meyerbeer prepared and achieved each of his great victories, and with what scrupulous care he weighed the succession of 'effects' in the opera itself, it is also possible to understand how shamed and incensed Wagner felt when his eyes were opened to the kind of 'artifices' the artist was virtually obliged to employ if he was to wrest a success from the public. I doubt whether there has been another great artist in all history who started out so greatly in error and who engaged in the most revolting form of his art with such goodwill and naivety: and yet the way in which he did it had greatness in it and was therefore extraordinarily fruitful. For out of the despair he felt when he came to recognize his error he also came to comprehend the nature of modern success, of the modern public and of the whole of modern artistic falsity. By becoming a critic of 'effect' he produced in himself the first trembling awareness of how he himself might be purified. It was as though from then on the spirit of music spoke to him with a wholly novel psychical magic. As if he were returning to life after a long illness, he hardly trusted his eyes or his hands, he crept along groping; and thus it appeared to him a miraculous discovery when he found he was still a musician, still an artist, indeed that it was only now that he had become a musician and artist at all. Every further stage in Wagner's evolution is characterized by a closer and closer union between his two fundamental drives: their wariness of one another diminishes, and hereafter his higher self no longer condescends to serve its violent, more earthly brother, it loves it and cannot but serve it. Finally, when the goal of this evolution has been reached, the most tender and pure elements are contained within the most powerful, the impetuous drive goes its way as before Richard Wagner in Bayreuth but along a different path to where the higher self is at home; and conversely, the latter descends to earth and in everything earthly recognizes its own image. If it were possible to speak in this fashion of the ultimate goal and issue of this evolution and still

remain intelligible, then it would also be possible to discover the ineta physical expression which would describe a lengthy, intermediate stage in this evolution; but I doubt if the former can be done, and I shall therefore not attempt the latter either. This intermediate stage can be distinguished historically from the earlier and later stages with two phrases: Wagner becomes a social revolutionary, Wagner recognizes that the only artist there has been hitherto is the poetizing folk. * He was led to both by the ruling idea which, after that period of great despair and atonement, appeared before him in a new shape and more powerfully than ever. Influence, incomparable influence by means of the theatre! - but over whom? He shuddered when he recalled those whom he had hitherto sought to influence. From his own experience he knew the whole shameful situation in which art and artists find themselves: how a soulless or soul-hardened society, which calls itself good but is in fact evil, counts art and artists as among its retinue of slaves whose task it is to satisfy its imagined needs. Modern art is luxury: he grasped that fact, as he did the fact that it must stand or fall with the society to which it belongs. Just as it has employed its power over the powerless, over the folk, in the most hardhearted and cunning fashion so as to render them ever more serviceable, base and less natural, and to create out of them the modern 'worker', so it has deprived the folk of the greatest and purest things its profoundest needs moved it to produce and in which, as the true and only artist, it tenderly expressed its soul! - its mythology, its song, its dance, its linguistic inventiveness - in order to distil from them a lascivious antidote to the exhaustion and boredom of its existence, the arts of today. How this society came into being, how it knew how to imbibe new strength from apparently antagonistic spheres of power, how for example Christianity degenerated to hypocrisy and superficiality and allowed itself to be used as a shield against the folk, as a fortress for this society and its property, and how science and scholarship offered themselves only too pliantly to * Paraphrasing Wagner, here and elsewhere in this essay, Nietzsche uses the word Volk in the sense in which Wagner used it, i.e. the 'people' or the 'nation' as a cultural, as opposed to political, entity. This sense of Volk has an English analogue in the phrases 'folk-story' and 'folk-music'; and, although the word by itself is now archaic in English, there seems to be no alternative to using it here. r i \ I ! -, I , I !-l n this forced service - all this Wagner pursued through the ages, only to spring up in rage and disgust when he had finished: he had become a revolutionary out of pity for the folk. From then on he loved the folk and yearned for them as he yearned after his art, for ah! it was only in them, only in the folk, though it was now artificially suppressed so that it could hardly any longer be imagined, that he now saw the only spectator and listener who might be worthy of and equal to the power of his art-work as he dreamed of it. Thus his reflections collected around the question: how does the folk come into being? how can it be resurrected? He found only one answer: - if

a multiplicity of people suffered the same need as he suffered, that would be the folk, he said to him self. And where the same need led to the same impulse and desire, the same kind of satisfaction must necessarily be sought and the same happiness discovered in this satisfaction. When he then cast around for that which cheered and consoled him the most in his need, which came to meet it most warmly and profoundly, he was aware with inspiring certainty that it could only be the myth and music - the myth which he recognized as the product and language of the folk's need, music having a similar though even more enigmatic origin. In these two elements he bathed and healed his soul, they were what he desired most ardently: - from this condition he could infer how closely related his need was to that experienced by the folk when it came into being, and in what manner the folk would have to be resurrected if there were to be many Wagners. How, then, did myth and music fare in our modern society, insofar as they had not fallen victim to it? They had both suffered a similar fate, a witness to their mysterious affinity: myth had been deeply debased and disfigured, transformed into the 'fairy tale', the plaything of the women and children of the degenerate folk and quite divested of its miraculous and serious manly nature; music had maintained itself among the poor and simple, among the solitary, the German musician had failed to establish himself in the luxury trade in the arts and had himself become a fairy tale full of monsters and touching sounds and signs, an asker of the wrong questions, something quite enchanted and in need of redemption. Here the artist heard clearly the command directed at him alone - to restore to the myth its manliness, and to take the spell from music and bring it to speech: all at once he felt his strength for drama unfettered, his right to rule over an as yet undiscovered middle realm between myth and music, established. He now set before mankind his new art-work, within Richard Wagner in Bayreuth which he had enclosed all he knew of power, effectiveness and joy, with the great, painfully incisive question: 'Where are you who suffer and desire as I do? Where are the many which I long to see become a folk? The sign by which I shall know you is that you shall have the same happiness and the same comfort in common with me: your suffering shall be revealed to me through your joy!' Thus he questioned in *Tannhäuser* and *Lohengrin*, thus he looked about him for his own kind; the solitary thirsted for the many. Yet what happened? No one answered, no one understood the question. Not that there was utter silence; on the contrary, there were answers to a thousand questions he had never asked at all, there were twitterings about the new art-works as though they had been created for the express purpose of being talked to pieces. The whole lust for aesthetic chattering and scribbling erupted among the Germans like a fever, the art-works and the person of the artist were assessed and fingered with that shamelessness which characterizes German scholars no less than it does German journalists. Wagner tried to assist an understanding of his question through prose

writings: fresh confusion, fresh buzzing - a musician who writes and thinks was to all the world in those days a monstrosity; then they cried: he is a theorist who wants to transform art according to intellectual concepts, stone him! - Wagner was as though stunned; his question had not been understood, his need not comprehended, his art-works were like communications to the deaf and blind, his folk was like a phantom; he reeled and faltered. The possibility of a total upheaval of all things rose before his eyes, and he no longer shrank from this possibility: perhaps a new hope could be erected on the other side of revolution and destruction, perhaps not - and in any event nothingness is better than something repulsive. Before long he was a political refugee and penniless. Yet it was only now, when his outward and inner destiny had taken so fearful a turn, that the great man entered upon the period of his life over which the light of supreme mastery lies like the glitter of liquid gold! Only now did the genius of the dithyrambic drama throw off his last concealment! He is utterly alone, time seems no thing to him, he has abandoned hope: thus his universal glance again descends into the depths, and this time to the very bottom: there he sees that suffering pertains to the essence of things and from then on, grown as it were more impersonal, he accepts his own share of suffering more calmly. The desire for supreme power, the inheritance of earlier years, is wholly translated into artistic creativity; now he speaks through his art only to himself and no longer to a 'public' or folk, and struggles to bestow upon it the greatest clarity and capacity to conduct such a mighty colloquy. His works too had been different during the preceding period: in them too he had, if nobly and tenderly, sought to produce an immediate effect: for these works were meant as a question designed to evoke an instant answer; and how often Wagner desired to make himself more easily understood by those to whom he put it - so that he went out to meet them and their inexperience in being questioned and conformed to older forms and means of expression; where he had to fear that he would fail to convince and be understood in his own language, he had tried to put his question in a tongue half foreign to him, though familiar to his listeners. Now there was no longer any thing to constrain him to such consideration; now he wanted only one thing: to come to terms with himself, to think of the nature of the world in the form of actions, to philosophize in sound; what was left in him of intentionality was bent upon the expression of his final insights. He who is worthy to know what took place in him then, what he was accustomed to discuss with himself in the darkest sanctuary of his soul - not many are worthy of it - let him hear, behold and experience *Tristan und Isolde*, the actual opus metaphysicum of all art, a work upon which there lies the broken glance of a dying man with his insatiable sweet longing for the mysteries of night and death, far distant from life, which, as evil, deception and separation, shines with an uncanny ghostly morning brightness and distinctness: and with this a drama of the most austere strictness of form,

ovelWhelming in its simple grandeur, and only thus adequate to the mystery of which it speaks, the mystery of death in life, of unity in duality. And yet there is something even more miraculous than this work: the artist himself, who after producing it could soon afterwards create a world of a completely different colouring, the Meistersinger von Niirnberg, and who was indeed, in these two works, only as it were resting and refreshing himself so as then to complete with measured pace the four-part giant structure he had already sketched out and begun, the object of his reflection and invention over twenty years, his Bayreuth art-work, the Ring des Nibelungen! Whoever can feel per plexed at the proximity of Tristan and the Meistersinger has failed to understand the life and nature of all truly great Germans on an important point: he does not know upon what basis alone that uniquely German cheerfulness exhibited by Luther, Beethoven and Wagner can grow, a kind of cheerfulness which other nations completely fail to Richard Wagner in Bayreuth understand and which contemporary Germans themselves Cpppear to have lost - that golden, thoroughly fermented mixture of sim plicity, the penetrating glance of love, reflective mind and roguish ness such as Wagner has dispensed as the most delicious of draughts to all who have suffered profoundly from life and return to it as it were with the smile of convalescents. And, as he himself looked upon the world with more reconciled eyes, was seized less often with rage and disgust, renounced power more in sorrow and love than with a shudder, as he thus quietly pushed forward his greatest work and laid score beside score, something happened which made him stop and listen: friends were coming to tell him of a subterranean movement of many souls - it was far from being the 'folk' that was here in motion and announcing itself, but perhaps the germ and first source oflife of a truly human community to be perfected in the dis tant future; for the present no more than a guarantee that his great work could one day be placed in the hands and care of faithful men charged with and worthy of guarding this most glorious oflegacies in the years to come; in the love of friends the days of his life began to shine in warmer colours; his noblest care and concern, as it were to reach the goal of his work before evening and to find for it a shelter, was no longer his care and concern alone. And then there occurred an event which he could understand only symbolically and which signified for him a new comfort, a sign of good fortune. A great German war made him look up, a war of those same Germans whom he knew to have degenerated and fallen so far from the German highminded ness which he had come to know from his observation of himself and of the other great Germans of history he saw that, in a quite tremendous situation, these Germans had exhibited two genuine virtues, simple bravery and presence of mind, and he began to think that perhaps he was not the last German and that one day his work would secure the protection of a more formidable power than that of his self-sacrificing but few friends, which would preserve it for that future

destined to it as the art-work of the future. Perhaps, when he sought to advance this belief to a hope of immediate realization, it was not always possible to shield it from doubt: it is enough that it gave to him a tremendous incitement to remember a lofty duty as yet unfulfilled. His work would not have been finished, not brought to a conclusion, if he had entrusted it to posterity only as a mute score; he had publicly to demonstrate and give instruction in what could not be guessed, in what he alone knew, of the new style needed for its III performance and representation, so as to provide a model no other could provide and thus found a stylistic tradition inscribed, not in signs on paper, but in effects upon the souls of men. This had become all the more serious a duty inasmuch as his other works had meanwhile suffered the most intolerable and absurd fate precisely in regard to the style of their performance: they were famous, admired and mishandled without anyone's apparently being indignant over the fact. For, strange though it may sound, as in clear-sighted knowledge of what his contemporaries were like he abandoned ever more earnestly the desire for success with them and renounced the idea of power, 'success' and 'power' came to him; at least all the world told him so. It was no good for him to expose repeatedly and emphatically how such 'successes' were complete misunderstandings and, to him, humiliations; people were so unused to seeing an artist distinguish between the differing effects produced by his works that even his most solemn protests were never really taken seriously. After he had realized the connection between our theatrical world and theatrical success and the character of contemporary man, his soul ceased to have anything to do with this theatre; he was no longer concerned with aesthetic enthusiasms or the jubilation of excited masses, indeed he was filled with wrath to see his art fed so indiscriminately into the gaping maw of insatiable boredom and thirst for distraction. Just how superficial and thoughtless every effect produced here must be, how here it was a matter rather of cramming a stomach never satisfied than of feeding a hungry one, he concluded especially from one regularly recurring phenomenon: everywhere, even on the part of the performers and producers, his art was taken to be precisely the same kind of thing as any other music for the stage and subjected to the rules of the repulsive recipe-book of ordinary opera production; indeed, the cultivated conductors cut and hacked at his works until they really were operas which, now they had had the soul taken out of them, the singers felt capable of encompassing; and when attempts were made to perform them properly, Wagner's directions were followed with the sort of ineptitude and prudish anxiety that would, for instance, represent the nocturnal riot in the streets of Nuremberg prescribed for the second act of the Meister singer with a troop of posturing ballet dancers and in all this everyone appeared to be acting in good faith and without any malicious intent. Wagner's self-sacrificing attempts to indicate by deed and example at any rate simple correctness and completeness in

the performance of his works, and to introduce individual singers to his Richard Wagner in Bayreuth quite novel style of execution, were repeatedly swept away by the sludge of prevailing thoughtlessness and habit; and these effects, moreover, always involved him in mixing with a theatre whose whole being had become for him an object of disgust. Did not Goethe himself lose the desire to attend performances of his own *Iphigenie*: 'I suffer dreadfully', he said in explanation, 'when I have to associate with these phantoms, who never appear as they ought to do.' Meanwhile his 'success' at this theatre grown repulsive to him continued to increase; finally the point was reached at which the great theatres lived for the most part on the fat takings brought them by the Wagnerian art-works disguised as operas. The confusion involved in this growing passion on the part of the opera public even seized hold on many of Wagner's friends: though he had suffered much in patience, he now had to suffer the worst and see his friends intoxicated by 'successes' and 'victories' precisely where his uniquely lofty idea was denied and derided. It almost seemed as though a people in many respects serious and ponderous was refusing to be deprived of a systematic levity in regard to its most serious artist, as though this were why everything vulgar, thoughtless, inept and malicious in the German character had to be discharged at him. - When, therefore, during the German War a more expansive and freer current of feeling seemed to come uppermost, Wagner remembered the duty imposed upon him by his loyalty to rescue at any rate his greatest work from the success born of misunderstanding and the abuse to which his other words had been subjected, and to present it at its own unique tempo as an example for all future time: thus he conceived the idea of Bayreuth. In the wake of that current of feeling he believed he saw an enhanced feeling of duty also awaken in those to whom he wished to entrust his most precious possession - and it was out of this feeling of mutual duty that there grew the event which lies like strange sunlight upon recent and immediately coming years; designed for the benefit of a distant future, a future that is merely possible but not demonstrable, a future that is to the present and to men knowing only the present not much more than an enigma or an abomination, to those few permitted to assist in its creation a foretaste and fore-experience of the highest kind through which they know themselves blessed, blessing and fruitful beyond their span of time, to Wagner himself a darkness of toil, care, reflection, wrath, a renewed raging of the hostile elements, but above all the light of the star of selfless loyalty and in this light transformed into an unspeakable happiness! One hardly needs to say that the breath of the tragic lies over this life. And everyone who can sense something of it from out of his own soul, everyone to whom the constraint of a tragic deception as to the goal of life, the bending and breaking of intentions, renunciation and purification through love are things not wholly unknown, must feel in that which Wagner now exhibits as an art-work a dreamlike recollection of the great man's own heroic

existence. From some far distance we shall believe we hear Siegfried telling of his deeds: into the touching happiness of recollection there is weaved the profound sadness of late summer, and all nature lies still in a yellow evening light. - To reflect on what Wagner the artist is, and to meditate on the spectacle of a truly liberated artistic capacity and autocracy, is something that everyone who has thought about and suffered from Iww Wagner the man evolved will have need of as a means of recovery and refreshment. If art in general is only the ability to communicate to others what one has experienced, if every art-work contradicts itself if it cannot make itself understood, then Wagner's greatness as an artist must consist in precisely that demonic communicability of his nature, which as it were speaks of itself in every language and makes known its inner, most personal experience with the extremest clarity; his appearance in the history of the arts is like a volcanic eruption of the total undivided artistic capacity of nature itself after humanity had accustomed itself to seeing the arts isolated from one another as though this were an eternal rule. One can thus be undecided which name to accord him, whether he should be called a poet or a sculptor or a musician, each word taken in an extraordinarily wide sense, or whether a new word has to be created to describe him. The poetic element in Wagner is disclosed by the fact that he thinks in visible and palpable events, not in concepts; that is to say, he thinks mythically, as the folk has always thought. The myth is not founded on a thought, as the children of an artificial culture believe, it is itself a mode of thinking; it communicates an idea of the world, but as a succession of events, actions and sufferings. *Der Ring des Nibelungen* is a tremendous system of thought without the conceptual form of thought. Perhaps a philosopher could set beside it something exactly corresponding to it but lacking in image or action and speaking to us merely in concepts: one would then have presented the same thing in two disparate spheres, once for the folk and once for the antithesis Richard Wagner in Bayreuth of the folk, the theoretical man. Thus Wagner does not address himself to the latter; for the theoretical man understands of the poetical, of the myth, precisely as much as a deaf man does of music, that is to say both behold a movement which seems to them meaningless. From within one of these disparate spheres one cannot see into the other: so long as one is under the spell of the poet one thinks with him, as though one were a being who only feels, sees and hears; the conclusions one draws are the linking together of the events one sees, that is to say factual causalities, not logical ones. Now, if the gods and heroes of such mythological dramas as Wagner writes are to communicate also in words, there is no greater danger than that this spoken language will awaken the theoretical man in us and thereby heave us over into the other, non-mythical sphere: so that in the end we should not through the employment of words have understood more clearly what is taking place before us but, on the contrary, have failed to understand it at all. That is why Wagner has

forced language back to a primordial state in which it hardly yet thinks in concepts and in which it is itself still poetry, image and feeling; the fearlessness with which Wagner set about this quite frightful task shows how forcibly he was led by the spirit of poetry, as one who has to follow wherever his ghostly guide may lead him. Every word of these dramas had to be able to be sung, and it had to be appropriate to gods and heroes: that was the tremendous demand Wagner presented to his linguistic imagination. Anyone else would surely have despaired of succeeding; for our language seems almost too old and too devastated for one to be able to demand of it what Wagner demanded: and yet the blow he struck against the rock called forth an abundant spring. Because he had loved this language more and demanded more of it than other Germans, Wagner had also suffered more from its degeneration and enfeeblement, from the manifold losses and mutilation it had sustained, from its clumsy sentence structure, from its unsingable auxiliary verbs - all things which have entered into the language through sin and depravity. On the other hand, he sensed with profound pride the natural originality and inexhaustibility still existing in this language, the resonant strength of its roots in which he suspected, in contrast to the highly derivative and artificially rhetorical languages of the Roman family, a wonderful inclination to and preparation for music, for true music. A joy in German permeates Wagner's poetry, a cordiality and ingenuousness in dealing with it that is to be encountered in no other German except Goethe. Individuality of expression, bold compression, forcefulness and rhythmic versatility, a remarkable richness in strong and significant words, simplification of sentence construction, an almost unique inventiveness in the language of surging feeling and presentiment, occasionally a quite pure bubbling up of popular colloquialisms and proverbiality - these are among the qualities that would have to be listed, and yet the mightiest and most admirable would still have been forgotten. Whoever reads, one after the other, two such poems as *Tristan* and the *Meistersinger* will feel a sense of amazement and perplexity in respect of the verbal language similar to that which he feels in respect of the music: namely, how it could have been possible to create two worlds as disparate in form, colour and articulation as they are in soul. This is the mightiest of Wagner's gifts, something that only a great master can succeed in: the ability to mint for every work a language of its own and to bestow upon a new subjectivity also a new body and a new sound. Where this rarest of powers expresses itself, censure of individual excesses and singularities, or of the more frequent obscurities of expression and thought, will always be no more than petty and unfruitful. Moreover, those who have hitherto censured most loudly have at bottom found not so much the language as the soul, the whole way of feeling and suffering, repellent and unheard-of. Let us wait until they themselves have acquired a new soul, then they themselves will also speak a new language: and then, it seems to

me, the German language as a whole will be in better shape than it is now. Before all, however, no one who reflects on Wagner as poet and sculptor of language should forget that none of the Wagnerian dramas is intended to be read, and thus they must not be impeded with the demands presented to the spoken drama. The latter wants to influence the feelings solely through concepts and words; this objective brings it beneath the sway of rhetoric. But in life passion is rarely loquacious: in the spoken drama it has to be if it is to communicate itself at all. When the language of a people is already in a state of decay and detrition, however, the poet of the spoken drama is tempted to give his thoughts and language unusual colours and to invent neologisms; he wants to elevate language so that it can again express exalted feelings and he thereby incurs the danger of not being understood at all. He likewise seeks to communicate some thing of nobility to the passions through witty aphorisms and conceits and thereby falls into another kind of danger: he appears false and artificial. For real passion does not speak in maxims, and the poetic easily arouses distrust of its honesty if it differs essentially from the reality. Richard Wagner in Bayreuth from this reality. Wagner, on the other hand, as the first to recognize the inner deficiencies of the spoken drama, presents every dramatic event in a threefold rendering, through words, gestures and music: the music transmits the fundamental impulses in the depths of the persons represented in the drama directly to the soul of the listeners, who now perceive in these same persons' gestures the first visible form of those inner events, and in the words a second, paler manifestation of them translated into a more conscious act of will. All these effects take place simultaneously without in the least interfering with one another, and compel him before whom such a drama is presented to a quite novel understanding and empathy, just as though his senses had all at once grown more spiritual and his spirit more sensual, and as though everything that longs to know is now in a free and blissful transport of knowing. Because every event in a Wagnerian drama, illumined from within as it is by music, communicates itself to the spectator with the utmost clarity, its author was able to dispense with all those means of which the poet of the spoken drama has need if he is to give the events of his play warmth and luminosity. The whole economy of the drama could be made simpler, the architect's rhythmic sense could again venture to reveal itself in the great overall proportions of the building; for there was now no motive whatever for that deliberate complexity and confusing multiplicity through which the poet of the spoken drama seeks to arouse interest and tension and then enhance them to a feeling of happy astonishment. The impression of idealized remoteness and nobility could now be achieved without artifice. Language retreated from rhetorical expansiveness to the economy and force of a speech of feeling: and although the performer talked about his deeds and feelings far less than before, the inward events which the poet of the spoken drama had hitherto kept off the stage on account of their

supposedly undramatic nature now compelled the listener to a passionate empathy with them, while the gestures which attended them needed to be only of the gentlest. Now, passion sung takes somewhat longer than passion spoken; music stretches feeling, as it were: from which it follows that in general the performer who is also a singer has to overcome that agitation of movement from which the spoken drama suffers. He finds himself drawn towards an ennoblement of his gestures, and he does so all the more in that the music has plunged his feelings into the bath of a purer aether and has thus involuntarily made them more beautiful. The extraordinary tasks Wagner has set his actors and singers will for generations to come incite them to competition with one another, so as at last to achieve a perfect visible and palpable representation of the image of the Wagnerian hero which already lies perfectly realized in the music of the drama. Following this lead, the eye of the plastic artist will at last behold the miracle of a new visible world such as only the creator of such works as the *Ring des Nibelungen* has seen before him: as a sculptor of the highest kind who, like Aeschylus, points the way to an art of the future. Indeed, must not the jealousy aroused when the plastic artist compares the effect of his art with that of such music as Wagner's not in itself inspire great talents: a music in which there reposes the purest sunlit happiness; so that to him who hears this music it is as though almost all earlier music had spoken in a superficial and constricted language, as though it were a game played before those unworthy of seriousness or a means of instruction and demonstration for those unworthy even of play. That earlier music inspires in us only for brief hours that happiness which we feel in Wagnerian music all the time: rare moments of forgetfulness when it speaks to itself alone and, like Raphael's Cecilia, directs its glance away from its listeners, who demand of it only distraction, merriment or scholarliness. Of Wagner the musician it can be said in general that he has bestowed a language upon everything in nature which has hitherto not wanted to speak: he does not believe that anything is obliged to be dumb. He plunges into daybreaks, woods, mist, ravines, mountain heights, the dread of night, moonlight, and remarks in them a secret desire: they want to resound. If the philosopher says it is one will which in animate and inanimate nature thirsts for existence, the musician adds: and this will wants at every stage an existence in sound. Before Wagner, music was as a whole narrowly bounded; it applied to the steady, permanent states of mankind, to that which the Greeks called *ethos*, and it was only with Beethoven that it began to discover the language of *pathos*, of passionate desire, of the dramatic events which take place in the depths of man. Formerly the objective was to give expression in sound to a mood, a state of determination or cheerfulness or reverence or penitence; by means of a certain striking uniformity of form, and through protracting this uniformity for some time, one wanted to compel the listener to interpret the mood of the music and in the end to be

transported into it himself. Different forms were needed for each of these images of different moods and states; other forms were determined by convention. The question of length was a matter for the judgment of the composer, who, while wanting to transport the listener into a certain mood, did not want to bore him by going on for too long. A further step was taken when images of antithetical moods were placed one after the other and the charm of contrast was discovered, and a further step still when a single musical movement took into itself an antithetical ethos, for example by allowing a masculine theme to come into conflict with a feminine theme. All these are still rude and primitive stages of music. The first law originated in fear of passion, the second in fear of boredom; all deepening and excess of feeling was felt to be 'unethical'. But when the art of ethos had presented the same customary states and moods in hundredfold repetition it finally succumbed to exhaustion, notwithstanding the marvellous inventiveness of its masters. Beethoven was the first to let music speak a new language, the hitherto forbidden language of passion: but because his art had grown out of the laws and conventions of the art of ethos, and had as it were to try to justify itself before them, his artistic development was peculiarly difficult and beset with confusions. An inner dramatic event - for every passion takes a dramatic course - wanted to break through to a new form, but the traditional scheme of the music of moods set itself in opposition and spoke against it almost as morality speaks against the rise of immorality. It sometimes seems as though Beethoven had set himself the contradictory task of expressing pathos through the forms of ethos. This idea is, however, inadequate to his last and greatest works. To reproduce the great vaulting arch of a passion he really did discover a new means: he removed individual portions of its flightpath and illuminated these with the greatest distinctness, so that from them the listener would divine the entire curve. Viewed superficially, the new form seemed like several musical movements put together, each of them apparently representing a single enduring state, in reality however a moment in the dramatic course of the passion. It could happen that the listener would think he was hearing the old music of mood but failing to grasp the relationship of the several parts to one another, which could no longer be understood by reference to the old canon of antithetical parts. Even among composers there arose a contempt for the demand for the construction of an artistic whole, and the sequence of the parts of their works became arbitrary. The invention of the grand form for the expression of passion led via a misunderstanding back to the single movement with whatever content the composer might choose, and the tension between different parts of a work ceased altogether. That is why the symphony after Beethoven is such a strangely confused structure, especially when in its individual parts it still stammers the language of Beethovenian pathos. The means are not appropriate to the

objective, and the objective as a whole is not at all clear to the listener because it was never clear to the composer either. But the demand that one should have something quite definite to say, and that one should say it as clearly as possible, is the more indispensable the higher, more difficult and more ambitious a species of work is. That is why Wagner's whole struggle was to find every means of procuring clarity; to this end he needed above all to liberate himself from every prejudice and claim of the older music of static states and to put into the mouth of his music, which may be called the operations of feeling and passion become sound, a speech free of all ambiguity. If we look at what he achieved, it must seem to us as though he has done in the realm of music what the inventor of free standing sculpture did in that of the plastic arts. Measured against Wagner's, all earlier music seems stiff or timid, as though it were ashamed to be seen from all sides. Wagner seizes every degree and every shade of feeling with the greatest sureness and definiteness: he takes the tenderest, most remote and wildest emotions in hand without fear of losing his grip on them and holds them as something hard and firm, even though to anyone else they may be as elusive as a butterfly. His music is never indefinite, indicating only a general mood; everything that speaks through it, man or nature, has a strictly individualized passion; storm and fire take on the compelling force of a personal will. Over all the individuals realized in sound and the struggles their passions undergo, over the whole vortex of opposing forces, there soars in the supremest self-possession an overwhelming symphonic intelligence which out of all this conflict brings forth concord: Wagner's music as a whole is an image of the world as it was understood by the great Ephesian philosopher: * a harmony produced by conflict, the unity of justice and enmity. I wonder at the fact that it is possible to calculate the grand course of a total passion out of a multiplicity of individual passions each heading in a different direction: that such a thing is possible I see demonstrated by each individual act of a Wagnerian drama, which narrates the personal history of various individuals together with a general history of *Heraclitus (sixth century BC). Richard Wagner in Bayreuth all of them. At the very beginning we sense that we have before us individual conflicting currents but at the same time a stream with a powerful directionality which is master of them all: this stream moves restlessly at first, over hidden jagged rocks, the flood some times seems to divide as though it wanted to go in different directions. Gradually we notice that the inner general movement has become more powerful, more compelling; the convulsive restlessness has passed over into a broad, fearfully strong movement towards an as yet unknown goal; and suddenly the whole breadth of the stream ends by plunging down into the depths with a demonic joy in the abyss and in its seething waves. Wagner is never more Wagner than when difficulties multiply tenfold and he can rule over great affairs with the joy of a lawgiver. To subdue contending masses to a simple rhythm, to

subject a multiplicity of demands and desires to the rule of a single will - these are the tasks for which he feels he was born, in the performance of which he feels himself free. He never loses his breath in the process, he never arrives at his goal panting. He has striven as ceaselessly to impose the harshest laws upon himself as others strive to lighten their burden; he is oppressed by life and art when he cannot play with their most difficult problems. Consider, for instance, the relation between sung melody and the melody of unsung speech, and how Wagner treats the pitch, volume and tempo of passionate human speech as a natural model which it is his task to transform into art: - consider how this sung passion is then ordered within the total symphonic complex of the music and recognize a miracle of difficulties overcome: his inventiveness here, in great things and small, the omnipresence of his spirit and his diligence, is such that at the sight of a Wagnerian score one could believe that before him there was no such thing as labour and exertion. It seems that, in regard to the toil involved in art too, he could have said that the actual virtue of the dramatist consists in self-sacrifice; but he would probably retort: there is only one kind of toil, that of him who has not yet become free; virtue and goodness are easy. Taken as a whole, Wagner as an artist has about him something of Demosthenes: a tremendous seriousness as to his subject combined with a strength of grip that seizes it every time without fail; he lays hold of it in a moment and his hand clings fast as though it were of brass. Like Demosthenes, he conceals his art or makes his audience forget it by compelling them to concentrate on the subject; and yet, again like Demosthenes, he is the last and highest exemplar of a 11th century; whole series of artistic spirits and consequently has more to conceal than the first in the series had; his art, as nature reproduced and rediscovered, has the effect of nature. He has nothing epideictic about him, as have all earlier composers who occasionally played a game with their art and put their mastery on display. At a performance of a Wagnerian art-work one is not aware of what is interesting or enjoyable, or of Wagner himself, or of art at all: one feels only the necessity of it all. What severity and uniformity of purpose he imposed upon his will, what self-overcoming the artist had need of in the years of his development so as at last in his maturity to do with joyful freedom what was necessary at every moment of creation, no one will ever be able to calculate: it is enough if we sense in individual cases how, with a certain cruelty of decision, his music subordinates itself to the course of the drama, which is as inexorable as fate, while the fiery soul of this art thirsts to roam about for once unchecked in the freedom of the wilderness. 10 An artist who possesses this power over himself subjugates all other artists even without wanting to do so. To him alone, on the other hand, do those he subjects, his friends and adherents, represent no danger or limitation: whereas lesser characters who seek support from their friends generally lose their freedom through them. It is wonderful to see how his whole life long Wagner has

avoided any kind of party, but how nonetheless a circle of adherents has formed itself behind every phase in the development of his art, apparently in order to keep him fixed at that phase. He was always able to frustrate this intention and to pass through to the next phase; his path has been too long, moreover, for any other individual to have found it easy to accompany him the whole way and so unusual and steep that even the most loyal would find themselves out of breath. At almost every stage of Wagner's life his friends would have liked to have laid down the law to him; and so, for different reasons, would his enemies. If the purity of his artistic character had been only a degree less firm he could have become the uncontested master of contemporary art and music a great deal sooner: - which is what he has finally become, though in the much higher sense that everything that takes place in any domain of art sees itself involuntarily set before the judgment seat of his art and his artistic character. He has subdued even the most reluctant: there is no longer any musician of Richard Wagner in Bayreuth talent who does not inwardly listen to him and find him more worth listening to than his own and all other music together. Some, determined to mean something at all cost, wrestle with this overwhelming inner influence, exile themselves to the circle of the older masters and prefer to found their 'independence' on Schubert -or Handel rather than on Wagner. In vain! By struggling against their better conscience, they themselves grow meaner and pettier as artists, they ruin their character by having to endure base friends and allies: and after all these sacrifices they still find themselves, perhaps in a dream, giving ear to Wagner. These opponents are pitiable: they believe they have lost a great deal when they lose themselves, but they are here in error. Now, it is plain that Wagner is not very much concerned whether composers from now on compose in a Wagnerian manner or whether they compose at all; indeed, he does what he can to destroy the unfortunate current belief that a school of composers must now necessarily attach itself to him. Insofar as he exercises a direct influence on present-day musicians he tries to instruct them in the art of grand execution; it seems to him that the evolution of the art has reached a point at which the will to become an efficient master of performance and practical musicianship is far more estimable than the thirst to be 'creative' at any cost. For, at the stage the art has now reached, such creativity, by multiplying and then wearing out through everyday use the techniques and inventions of genius, has the fatal consequence of trivializing the effect of what is truly great. In art, even the good is superfluous and harmful when it originates in imitation of the best. Wagnerian means and ends belong together: to feel the truth of this requires nothing more than artistic honesty, and it is dishonesty to observe the means and then employ them for quite different, pettier ends. If Wagner thus declines to live among a crowd of composers all composing away in the Wagnerian manner, he is all the more insistent in setting every talent the new task of discovering together

with him the stylistic laws of dramatic performance. He feels a profound need to found for his art a stylistic tradition by means of which his work could live on unalloyed from one age to the next until it attains that future for which its creator has destined it. 'Wagner possesses the insatiable urge to impart everything pertaining to this foundation of a style and thereby to the continuing existence of his art. To make his work, as a sacred deposit and true fruit of his existence (to employ an expression of Schopenhauer's), the property of mankind, to lay it down for a posterity better able to judge it, has become to him a goal which takes precedence over all other goals and for the sake of which he wears the crown of thorns which shall one day blossom into a laurel-wreath: his efforts are concentrated on the safeguarding of his work just as decidedly as are those of the insect in its final stage on safeguarding its eggs and on caring for the brood whose existence it will never know: it deposits the eggs where it knows for sure they will one day find life and nourishment, and dies contented. This goal, which takes precedence over all other goals, inspires him to ever new inventions; the more clearly he feels himself in conflict with his most unresponsive age and its utter unwillingness to listen, the more abundantly does he draw on the well of his demonic genius for communication. Gradually, however, even this age begins to give way before his unwearying promptings and enticements and lends him its ear. Whenever an opportunity, great or small, of elucidating his thoughts by practical example appeared in the distance, Wagner was prepared for it: he applied his ideas to the circumstances obtaining and made them speak even out of the most inadequate embodiments. Whenever an even halfway receptive soul appeared he cast his seed into it. He attached his hopes to things at which the cold observer shrugged his shoulders; he was willing to deceive himself a hundred times if it meant being once in the right as against this observer. As the wise man traffics with living men only so far as he can thereby augment the treasury of his knowledge, so it almost seems as though the artist can have no traffic with the men of his age except that through which he can perpetuate his art: to love him means to love his art and its perpetuation, and he likewise understands only one kind of hatred directed at himself, that which seeks to break down the bridges between his art and its future. The pupils Wagner reared for himself, the individual musicians and performers to whom he spoke a word or illustrated a gesture, the great and modest orchestras he directed, the towns which saw him earnestly at work, the princes and women who, half timidly, half with love, participated in his plans, the various European countries of which he was temporarily the judge and bad conscience: all gradually became an echo of his idea, of his inexhaustible striving for a fruitfulness in the future; if this echo often returned to him distorted and confused, in the end it grew to the overwhelming chorus which the overwhelming intensity of the message he cried to the world was bound finally to evoke; and soon it will be impossible not to

hear him or to mis- Richard Wagner in Bayreuth understand him. Already this chorus is making the art-centres of modern man tremble; whenever the breath of his spirit has wafted into these gardens, everything withered and ready to fall there has been shaken; and even more eloquent than this trembling is a universal uncertainty: no one knows any longer where the influence of Wagner may not suddenly break out. He is quite incapable of regarding the welfare of art as being in any way divorced from the general welfare: wherever the modern spirit represents a danger of any kind, there with the most observant mistrust he also suspects a danger to art. In his imagination he takes apart the building of our civilization and lets nothing decayed, nothing frivolously constructed, escape; if he encounters firm walls or durable foundations, he at once thinks of a way of employing them as bulwarks and protective roofs for his art. He lives like a fugitive whose aim is to preserve, not himself, but a secret; like an unfortunate woman who wants to save the life of the child she carries in her womb, not her own: he lives like Sieglinde, 'for the sake of love' . * For it is, to be sure, a life full of torment and shame, to be a homeless wanderer in a world to which one nonetheless has to speak and of which one has to make demands, which one despises and yet is unable to do without - it is the actual predicament of the artist of the future; he cannot, like the philosopher, hunt after knowledge all by himself in a dark corner, for he needs human souls as mediators with the future, public institutions as guarantees of this future, as bridges between the now and the hereafter. His art is not to be embarked on the ship of the written word, as the philosopher's work can be: art wants performers as transmitters, not letters and notes. Across whole stretches of Wagner's life there resounds a fear that he will not meet these performers and that, instead of the practical example he ought to give them, he will be forced to confine himself to indications in writing, and instead of active demonstration present the merest shadow of it to those who read books, which means on the whole those who are not artists. Wagner as a writer is like a brave man whose right hand has been cut off and who fights on with his left: he always suffers when he writes, because a temporarily ineluctable necessity has robbed him of the ability to communicate in the way appropriate to him, in the * In *Die Walkure*, Sieglinde, the mother of Siegfried, is urged by Brinnhilde to 'live for the sake of love' by saving herself from the wrath of Wotan, not for her own sake, but for that of the child she is carrying. form of aluminous and victorious example. His writings contain nothing canonical, nothing strict and severe: what is canonical is in his works. They are attempts to comprehend the instinct which impelled him to create his works, and as it were to set himself before his own eyes; if he can only manage to transform his instinct into knowledge, he hopes the reverse process will take place within the souls of his readers: it is with this objective that he writes. If it should in the event prove that he was here attempting the impossible, Wagner would

nonetheless only be sharing the same fate as all those who have reflected on art; and over most of them he has the advantage of being the repository of the mightiest instinct for all the arts collectively. I know of no writings on aesthetics so illuminating as Wagner's; what is to be learned about the birth of a work of art is to be learned from them. It is one of the truly great artists who here appears as a witness and through a long course of years deposes his testimony ever more freely, clearly and distinctly; even when he blunders in a point of knowledge he nonetheless strikes fire. Certain of his writings, such as *Beethoven*, *On Conducting*, *On Actors and Singers* and *State and Religion*, strike dumb every urge to contradiction and compel one to regard them with the silent reverence appropriate to the opening of a precious shrine. Others, especially those of earlier years and including *Opera and Drama*, are disturbing: they evidence an irregularity of rhythm through which they are, as prose, thrown into disorder. Their argumentation is full of gaps, and their emotional leaps hinder rather than accelerate their progress; a kind of reluctance on the part of the writer lies over them like a shadow, as though the artist is ashamed of intellectual demonstration. The hardest thing of all about them for those not wholly initiated is, perhaps, an impression they give of dignified self-assertiveness; it is a tone peculiar to them and one hard to describe: to me it seems as though Wagner were often speaking in the presence of enemies - for all these writings are in spoken, not in written style, and one will find them much clearer if one hears them read well aloud enemies with whom he cannot be familiar or intimate and at whom he is thus compelled to declaim from a distance. But sometimes his passionate engagement breaks through this deliberate dignity of style, and then the artificial, verbose and laboured periods vanish and there escape from him sentences and whole pages which are among the most beautiful in all German prose. Even supposing, however, that in such passages he is speaking to his friends and that the spectre of his enemies has for the moment vacated its place by his chair, all the friends and enemies Richard Wagner in Bayreuth Wagner addresses as a writer nonetheless have something in common which distinguishes them fundamentally from that 'folk' for whom he creates as an artist. In the refinement and unfruitfulness of their culture they are altogether divorced from the world of the folk, and he who wants to make himself understood by them has to speak in a manner divorced from that of the folk: as our best prose writers have done and as Wagner also does. With what degree of self-constraint we can guess. But the force of the drive, protective and as it were motherly, which he brings to every sacrifice draws him back into the atmosphere of the scholar and the cultivated to which as a creator he has said farewell for ever. He subjects himself to the language of culture and to all its laws of communication, even though he was the first to feel the profound inadequacy of this form of communication. For if there is anything that sets his art apart from all other art of modern times it is

this: it no longer speaks the language of the culture of a caste and in general no longer recognizes any distinction between the cultivated and the uncultivated. It therewith sets itself in opposition to the entire culture of the Renaissance, which had previously enveloped us modern men in its light and shade. By transporting us for moments out of this mantle of light and shade, Wagner's art enables us for the first time to see how uniform that whole period was: Goethe and Leopardi then appear to us as the last great followers of the Italian philologist-poets, Faust as a representation of the riddle propounded by modern times of the theoretical man who thirsts for real life - an enigma the furthest removed from the world of the folk; even the Goethean song is an imitation of a folk-song, not an example of it, and the poet well knew why he admonished one of his followers with the words: 'My things cannot become popular; whoever thinks they can and tries to make them so is in error.' That it was in any way possible for an art to exist which was so bright and warm that it would both enlighten the poor and lowly and melt the arrogance of the learned was something that could not be divined before it had come about. But now that it has come about, it must transform every notion of education and culture in the spirit of everyone who experiences it; it will seem to him that a curtain has been raised on a future in which there are no longer any great and good things except those which all hearts share in common. The ill odour which has hitherto clung to the word 'common' will then have been removed from it. If we venture thus to gaze into the future, we are also aware of the uncanny social insecurity which characterizes our own times and cannot conceal from ourselves the peril facing an art which seems to have no roots at all if it does not have them in the distant future, and which reveals to us its blossoming branches rather than the foundation out of which it grows. How can we preserve this homeless art so that it shall survive into this future? How can we dam the flood of , the apparently ineluctable revolution in such a way that this happy anticipation and guarantee of a better future, a freer humanity, is not also swept away with all that which is dedicated to and worthy of destruction? Whoever feels this anxiety participates in Wagner's anxiety; with him, he will feel himself driven to seek out those existing powers which have the will to be the guardian spirits of mankind's noblest property through these coming times of earthquake and upheaval. It is only in this sense that Wagner in his writings inquires of the cultivated whether they are willing to take his legacy, the precious ring of his art, into their treasure-house; and even the sublime trust which Wagner has reposed in the German spirit even in respect of its political goals seems to me to have its origin in his crediting the nation of the Reformation with that strength, kindness and bravery needed to 'divert the sea of revolution into the quietly flowing stream of humanity': and I could almost think that this and nothing else is what he intended to express through the symbolism of his Kaisennarsch. * In general, however, the creative artist's urge to help is too

great, . the horizon of his philanthropy too spacious, for his purview to be limited to the area bounded by any one nation. His conceptions are, like those of every great and good German, supra-German, and his art speaks, not to nations, but to individual men. But to men of the future. This is the faith which characterizes him, his torment and his distinction. No artist at any time in the past has received so remarkable a dowry from his genius, no one but he has had to imbibe with that draught of nectar enthusiasm has dispensed for him so sharp a drop of bitterness. It is not, as one might suppose, the misunderstood, mistreated and as it were fugitive artist who adopted this faith as a means of defence: success or failure in the eyes of his contemporaries. The Emperor March, composed by Wagner in 1871 to celebrate the founding of the Reich. Richard Wagner in Bayreuth parades could neither raise it up nor account for it. Whether it praised or rejected him, he did not belong to this generation: - that was the judgment of his instinct; and that there will ever be a generation, that belongs to him cannot be proved to him who does not already believe it. But even this unbeliever can, however, pose the question as to what a generation would have to be like if Wagner was to recognize in it his 'folk', as the epitome of all those who feel a need in common and want to be redeemed from it through an art in common. Schiller, to be sure, was more believing and more hopeful: he did not ask what an age would be like if the instinct of the artist who prophesies it should prove sound, he rather demanded of the artists: Erhebet euch mit kühnem Flügel Hoch über euren Zeitenlauf! Fern dämmre schon in eurem Spiegel Das kommende Jahrhundert auf! - Raise yourselves on daring wing high above your own age! Let the coming century distantly dawn already in your mirror! It may sane reason preserve us from the belief that mankind will at any future time attain to 'a final ideal order of things, and that happiness will then shine down upon it with unwavering ray like the sun of the tropics: with such a belief Wagner has nothing to do, he is no utopian. If he cannot cease to believe in the future this means no more than that he perceives in the men of today qualities which do not belong to the unalterable character and bone-structure of human nature but are changeable, indeed transitory, and that it is precisely because of these qualities that art has to be homeless among them and he himself has to be the herald of another age. No golden age, no cloudless sky is allotted to this coming generation to which his instinct directs him and whose vague lineaments can, so far as it is possible to infer the nature of the need from the nature of the gratification, be discerned in the secret writing of his art. Neither will suprahuman goodness and justice span the fields of this future like an immovable rainbow. Perhaps this generation as a whole will even seem more evil than the present generation - for, in wicked as in good things, it will be more candid; it is possible, indeed, that if its soul should speak out in free full tones it would shake and terrify our soul as would the voice of some hitherto concealed evil spirit of nature. Or how do these

propositions strike us: that passion is better than stoicism and hypocrisy; that to be honest, even in evil, is better than to lose oneself in the morality of tradition; that the free man can be good or evil but the unfree man is a disgrace to nature and is excluded from both heavenly and earthly solace; finally, that he who wants to become free has to become so through his own actions and that freedom falls into no one's lap like a miraculous gift. However shrill and uncanny all this may sound, what speaks here is the voice of that world of the future which has a genuine need of art and which can thus expect genuine satisfaction from it; it is the language of nature restored also in the world of man, it is precisely that which I earlier called right feeling, in contrast to the false feeling which predominates today. But only nature can enjoy genuine satisfactions and redemptions: unnature and false feeling cannot do so. If it should become aware of itself, unnature can only long for nothingness, while nature desires transformation through love: the former wants not to be, the latter wants to be different. Let him who has grasped this pass in review, in all quietness of soul, the simple themes of Wagner's art, and ask him self whether it is nature or unnature, as they have just been described, where here pursues its goals. A man homeless and despairing finds redemption from his torment through the compassionate love of a woman who prefers to die rather than be unfaithful to him: the theme of the *Fliegende Holländer*. - A loving woman, renouncing all happiness for herself, becomes, in a heavenly transformation of amor into caritas, a saint, and saves the soul of him she loves: the theme of *Tannhäuser*. - The highest and most glorious descends to men out of desire for them and will not be asked whence it has come; when the fatal question is asked, under a painful compulsion it returns to its higher life: the theme of *Lohengrin*. The loving soul of woman and of the folk are happy to receive the new beneficent genius, although the preservers of tradition defame and repulse it: the theme of the *Meistersinger*. - Two lovers who are unaware they are in love, but believe on the contrary that they are deeply wounded and despised by one another, demand from one another a death-potion, apparently to expiate their offence but in reality from an unconscious impulse: they want to be freed by death from all separation and dissimulation. The supposed proximity of death unbinds their souls and conducts them to a brief, dreadful happiness, as though they really had escaped from day and delusion, indeed from life: the theme of *Tristan und Isolde*. In the *Ring des Nibelungen* the tragic hero is a god who thirsts after power and who, through neglecting no path to its attainment, binds Richard Wagner in Bayreuth himself with treaties, loses his freedom, and becomes enmeshed in the curse which lies upon all power. His unfreedom is brought home to him especially by the fact that he no longer has any means of getting possession of the golden ring, the epitome of all earthly power and representing at the same time the most extreme danger to himself so long as it is in the possession of his enemies: he is

over come by fear of the ending and twilight of all the gods and by despair at being able only to watch this ending approach and do nothing to prevent it. He needs a free, fearless human being who, without his assistance or advice, indeed in conflict with the divine order, will of his own volition perform the deed denied to the god: this human being is nowhere to be seen, and it is precisely when a new hope of him dawns that the god is compelled to obey the constraint that binds him: what he loves most he has to destroy, and has to punish an act of the purest pity. At length he comes to feel a disgust for power, which bears in its womb only evil and unfreedom, his will breaks, he himself longs for the ending that threatens him from afar. And only now does there come to pass that which previously he had most desired: the free, fearless human being appears, born in conflict with all that is custom and tradition; his begotten expiate the fact that their union was counter to the order of nature and morality: they perish, but Siegfried lives. At the sight of his wonderful evolution and blossoming, disgust gives way in Wotan's soul, he follows the hero's fortunes with the eye of fatherly love and anxiety. How he forges the sword for himself, slays the dragon, gains the ring, eludes the cunningest deception, awakens Brunnhilde; how the curse that lies on the ring does not spare even him but approaches him closer and closer; how, loyal in disloyalty, wounding through love her he loves most, he is engulfed by the mists and shadows of guilt, but at last emerges as clear as the sun and goes under, igniting the whole heavens with his fiery glow and cleansing the world of the curse: all this the god - whose commanding spear has been shattered in combat with the freest of men, who has thereby deprived him of his power - beholds with joy at his own defeat, rejoicing and at one with his conqueror: his eye reposes with the light of a painful blissfulness upon the concluding events, he has become free in love, free from himself. And now ask yourselves, you who are living today! Was this created for you? Have you the courage to point to the stars in this celestial vault of beauty and goodness and say: it is our life that Wagner has set among the stars! Where among you are those able to interpret the divine image of Wotan by reference to their own life and who themselves, like him, grow ever greater the further they withdraw? Which of you will renounce power, in the knowledge and experience that power is evil? Where are those who, like Brunnhilde, relinquish their wisdom out of love and yet in the end learn from their life the highest wisdom of all: 'deepest suffering of sorrowing love opened my eyes'. And where are the free and fearless, those who in innocent selfishness grow and blossom out of themselves, the Siegfrieds among you? He who thus asks, and asks in vain, will have to look towards the future; and if in some remote age his glance should discover precisely that 'folk' for whom Wagner's art is a record of its own history, he will also have finally come to understand what Wagner will be to this folk: something he cannot be to any of us, namely not the seer of a future, as he would perhaps like to appear to us, but

the interpreter and transfigurer of a past. *Words of Briinnhilde in one of the many different versions Wagner wrote of the closing scene of *Giitterdiimmerung*: not in the final version set to music, but included in a passage appended as a footnote to the sceD in the 1872 edition of the Ring text.

Part III

Human, All Too Human

1878–1880 — Translated by R.J. Hollingdale

CONTENTS Introduction page vii Chronology xxiv Further Reading xxvi Human, All Too Human Volume I Preface 1 Of First and Last Things 2 On the History of the Moral Sensations 3 The Religious Life 6o 4 From the Souls of Artists and Writers 8o 5 Tokens of Higher and Lower Culture 6 Man in Society 7 Woman and Child 8 A Glance at the State 9 Man Alone with Himself Among Friends: An Epilogue Volume II Preface Part One Assorted Opinions and Maxims Part Two The Wanderer and His Shadow Index INTRODUCTION 'Human, All Too Human is the monument of a crisis.' With these apt words Nietzsche began his own reflection, in his autobiographical *Ecce Homo* (1888), on this remarkable collection of almost 1t aphorisms published in three instalments, the first of which had appeared in 1878, ten years earlier. The crisis to which he refers was first and foremost a crisis of multiple dimensions in his own life. Human, All Too Human was the extended product of a period of devastating health problems that necessitated Nietzsche's resignation in 1879 from his professorship in classical philology at Basel University. These problems were to plague him for the remaining decade of his brief productive life (which ended with his complete physical and mental collapse in January 1889, at the age of 44, from which he never recovered in the eleven years of marginal existence that remained to him before his death in 1900). Human, All Too Human also marked Nietzsche's transition from the philologist and cultural critic he had been into the kind of philosopher and writer he came to be. But the crisis was above all a crisis in Nietzsche's intellectual development; and although it was very much his own, it presaged the larger crisis toward which he came to see our entire culture and civilization moving, and subsequently came to call 'the death of God'.> In his own case, this crisis was precipitated not only by his deepening appreciation of the profound and extensive consequences of the collapse of traditional ways of thinking, but also - and more immediately - by his growing recognition of the insufficiency of the resources of both the Enlightenment and the Romanticism to which he had been so strongly attracted to fill the void. The three instalments of Human, All Too Human are no less important for the insight they yield into the kind of struggle in which Nietzsche was engaged than they are for the many sparks that fly in the course of his efforts to find new ways to go on. The world around Nietzsche did not appear to be a world headed for crisis. The

ordeals, horrors and dramatic changes of the century to come were largely unimagined, and indeed unimaginable, even to Nietzsche, who was far more prescient than most- even to the point of deeming the advent of air travel to be inevitable (1:267). In 1876, when he began working on the material that was published two years later in what is now the first volume of *Human, All Too Human*, Europe was again at (relative) peace. It had been ten years since the Austro-Prussian War that had left Prussia dominant in Central Europe; and it had been five years since the brief Franco-Prussian INTRODUCTION War (in which Nietzsche had briefly served as a volunteer medical orderly, with disastrous consequences for his health), which further enhanced and extended Prussia's sway, this time at France's expense. German unification under Prussian leadership had been achieved in 1871, and the new Reich appeared to be thriving, with Wilhelm on the throne and (more importantly) Otto von Bismarck at the helm. Everything seemed to be coming along very nicely for Western civilization in general, Europe in particular and Germany more specifically. It was the heyday of European imperialism, with India recently incorporated into the British Empire, and much of the rest of the non-Western world coming under European sway. The industrial revolution was sweeping all before it, and capitalism was triumphant. New technologies and modes of transportation and communication were transforming Western societies. (Nietzsche himself must have been one of the very first philosophers to own one of the newly invented typewriters, although it proved to be of little use to him.) Despite the success of conservative elements of European societies in retaining their social position and political power, forces preparing the way for their eventual replacement by more popular forms of social, cultural, economic and political organization-for better or for worse -were gathering. The physical sciences were advancing spectacularly; and while the influence of Karl Marx and Sigmund Freud had yet to be felt, the social and historical disciplines were maturing, and the biological sciences were coming on strong. Charles Darwin already loomed large. His *Origin of Species* had been published in 1859, and his *Descent of Man* in 1871. Germany, making up for lost time, was emerging as an economic, political and technological powerhouse, as well as the world's new leader in many of the sciences. It also continued its century-long dominance in philosophy, with ever-mutating forms of idealism, neo-Kantianism, naturalism and materialism competing in the aftermath of Hegel. Religion, enjoying official state status in many countries and the unquestioning allegiance of the vast majority of their populations, seemed immune from serious challenge. The arts, literature and music were flourishing as well, in Germany as elsewhere in Europe; and in 1876 the frenzy surrounding Richard Wagner - to which Nietzsche was no stranger - rose to new heights, with the opening of Bayreuth, and the performance of the first complete four-opera cycles of Wagner's monumental *Ring of the Nibelungs*.

Yet Nietzsche was convinced that all was far from well. He was repelled by the popular culture and brave new social, economic and political world burgeoning around him, and could no longer take seriously the intellectual and religious tradition associated with it. By 1876 he also found himself increasingly estranged from the newly fashionable alternatives to the tradition that its critics and rivals had been touting, including his erstwhile idols and mentors Arthur Schopenhauer and Wagner. Everywhere he looked, even at those things and thinkers supposedly representing the pride of our culture and the zenith of humanity, what he saw was not only far from divine but all-too-human. viii INTRODUCTION

Nietzsche had long yearned - and continued to yearn throughout his productive life - for a higher humanity with a worth great enough to warrant the affirmation of life even in the absence of any transcendently supplied meaning. He now had come to the hard realization that the only possible way to that higher humanity required an uncompromising examination of everything human and all-too-human that at once stands in our way and is our point of departure, and a sober stocktaking of what there is to work with in undertaking what he was later to call the enhancement of human life. The idea and ideal he seized upon at this juncture to guide and accompany him was that of the 'free spirit', older and wiser heir of the Enlightenment. Nietzsche paid explicit tribute to the ethos of this newly adopted lineage in his dedication of the first edition of *Human, All Too Human* to Voltaire, Enlightenment thinker par excellence, who had died exactly a century earlier, and whose spirit he now embraced. *Human, All Too Human* was Nietzsche's second book; and it was as far removed from the kind of book professors of classical languages and literatures were supposed to write as anything could be. His first book, *The Birth of Tragedy* (1872), had been a scandal in the eyes of his scholarly colleagues owing to its disregard of prevailing norms of scholarship and its blatant advocacy of Wagner as the reincarnation of the spirit of the tragic culture of the Greeks - but it at least had a recognizably classical literary topic. *Human, All Too Human*, as initially published, was a volume of 638 aphorisms - that is, short observations and reflections ranging from one or two sentences to a long paragraph, of a relatively self-contained nature. This style was a radically new one for Nietzsche, reminiscent of the writings of such observers of the human scene as Montaigne and La Rochefoucauld. Nietzsche had long greatly admired their manner of thought and expression, and found himself drawn to emulate them in his search for a voice that lent itself both to his own changing temperament and circumstances and to the decidedly unphilological tasks towards which he was turning. The publication of *Human, All Too Human* completed Nietzsche's estrangement from his erstwhile scholarly profession, from which he officially retired shortly thereafter. It also completed his much more painful estrangement from Wagner, whose devoted admirer, champion and intimate younger friend

Nietzsche had been. Nietzsche himself claimed to have begun writing the book in reaction to the first Bayreuth production of Wagner's Ring cycle, the entire social spectacle of which appalled him; and although he in fact would appear to have begun work on it some months earlier, in the spring of 1876, it certainly was written during a period in which his formerly close relationship to Wagner had become severely strained. Nietzsche knew that Wagner would loathe the book; and its dedication to Voltaire was undoubtedly a very deliberate gesture of defiance and independence in Wagner's direction. Eight years after its first publication, when Nietzsche republished it, he dropped the dedication- perhaps because he no longer wanted Voltaire to be taken as paradigmatic of his evolving conception of the 'free spirit', but perhaps also because Wagner by then had died, and such gestures were no longer either needed or fitting.

ix I N T R O D U C T I O N

In his discussion in *Ecce Homo* of the 'crisis' of which *Human, All Too Human* was the 'monument', Nietzsche goes on to say of it: 'Here I liberated myself from what in my nature did not belong to me.' He had given *Human, All Too Human* the subtitle 'A Book for Free Spirits'; and he went on to characterize the 'free spirit' in similar language, as 'a spirit that has become free, that has again taken possession of itself'.³ Among the things he clearly had in mind were his attachments to Schopenhauer and Wagner, who had been at the centre of his intellectual life for the previous decade. They had been the subjects of his last two major publications prior to *Human, All Too Human*, in which he had lavished praise upon them even while privately beginning to distance himself from them: *Schopenhauer as Educator* (1874) and *Richard Wagner in Bayreuth* (1876), the final two essays of his four-part *Untimely Meditations*. A student of classical languages and literatures rather than of philosophy, it had been Nietzsche's accidental discovery of Schopenhauer's magnum opus *The World as Will and Representation* in 1865 that had introduced - and seduced- him to philosophy. His spiritual seduction by Wagner three years later (in 1868) influenced him even more profoundly. The spell cast upon him by the two of them together is very apparent both in his thinking and enthusiasms in *The Birth of Tragedy* and in the fact that he ventured to write and publish such a book. Nietzsche's father had died when he was a young child; and he in effect adopted Schopenhauer as his intellectual godfather and Wagner as his emotional and spiritual father figure. It was for good reason that it occurred to him to write in aphorism 381 of the first volume of *Human, All Too Human*: 'Correcting nature. - If one does not have a good father one should furnish oneself with one.' Yet by the time he wrote these words he was well beyond this point, attempting to liberate himself from the fathers with whom he had furnished himself. It is well worth bearing in mind who the Nietzsche was who published this book of aphorisms in 1878. Neither he nor anyone else had the slightest idea of what he would go on to do and become. He was a 33-year-old philology professor whose

health and academic career were both failing badly. His youthful vigour and promise were now but sadly faded memories to his professional colleagues. His only book, published six years earlier, was the scandalous *Birth of Tragedy*; and his only subsequent publications of any significance were the two essays just mentioned and two previous 'untimely meditations', *David Strauss, the Confessor and the Writer* (1873) and *On the Uses and Disadvantages of History for Life* (1874). His enthusiasm for and association with Wagner had earned him a certain notoriety, but it had done him no good academically; and he otherwise had little reputation at all, except perhaps as a gamble that had appeared not to be working out. He was not thought of as a philosopher, having had no philosophical training and having published nothing resembling a conventional philosophical treatise. He had written a short, ambitious but sketchy essay, 'On Truth and Lies in a Nonmoral Sense', several years earlier; but it remained unfinished, and he never did publish it. His thoughts had indeed begun to turn toward philosophy, and he had even gone so far as to apply for the Chair in Philosophy at Basel when it became vacant; but he was unsuccessful in this attempt to switch professions, for reasons that are easy enough to understand. Even if *Human, All Too Human* had been published by a professional philosopher, it very probably would not have been regarded as a contribution to the philosophical literature by academic philosophers either in Nietzsche's own time or subsequently. Nor is it clear that it should be; for there is much in it that does not seem to have much to do with philosophical matters. Even the ideas on philosophical topics it addresses are seldom presented in recognizably philosophical ways. More of it can be seen as having philosophical relevance in retrospect, particularly if one looks back upon it with Nietzsche's later writings in mind, and if one's idea of philosophical relevance has been influenced by the impact of his thinking with respect to the philosophical enterprise. Even so, however, all three instalments of the work are very much the product of a mind in transition, moving in many different directions and in many different ways, heedless of disciplinary boundaries and norms, with only Nietzsche's interests and intellectual conscience as his map and compass. The aphoristic form Nietzsche adopted (and adapted to his purposes) in *Human, All Too Human* had long been a favoured literary form of observers of the human scene who preferred to comment incisively on many things, rather than writing essays about a selected few. But this form may also have been virtually necessitated by Nietzsche's increasingly severe and disabling health problems, which frequently rendered him incapable of writing or even thinking for extended periods of time. He had to make maximum use of the short periods of respite that came to him between frequent and extended bouts of misery. He struggled to surmount his wretched condition, and did so to much greater effect than most people in his situation could; but it was a hard and tortured struggle, giving poignant

significance to his subsequent emphasis upon 'hardness', self-mastery, self-discipline, and to his refusal to become preoccupied and deterred by suffering. The flair he discovered in himself for aphoristic writing at this time thus accorded well with necessity. It would be unwarranted, however, to assume that Nietzsche's recourse to it is indicative of the absence of any underlying unity and coherence of thought and intention here and subsequently. So he himself observes in aphorism 128 of the second instalment, very much to this point: 'Against the shortsighted. - Do you think this work must be fragmentary because I give it to you (and have to give it to you) in fragments?' Nietzsche had long been plagued by poor eyesight and eye pain that would afflict him when he either read or wrote extensively, by migraine headaches and by indigestion and other gastric problems that made him pay a high price for departures from the blandest of diets. His problems were compounded by a variety of ailments - dysentery and diphtheria among them- he contracted while serving as an orderly during the Franco-Prussian War, the effects of which continued to plague him. And the syphilis he seems somehow to have acquired (despite leading a virtually celibate life), that was the likely cause of his final collapse a dozen years later, may well have begun xi I N T R O D U C T I O N to contribute to the deterioration of his health during the gestation period of *Human, All Too Human*. So Nietzsche went from one health crisis to another, finding the rigours and burdens of his academic position increasingly difficult to bear, despite the fact that he rarely had as many as a dozen students attending his lectures. He often was unable to read or write, and frequently was obliged to take medical leaves from his teaching. His collapses were all too common, and at times he was virtually an invalid. He visited clinics, spas and specialists, whose diagnoses and prescriptions may often have only made things worse. Alternating bouts of blinding headaches and wracking vomiting would last for days; and his lecturing became ever more sporadic and difficult. Finally, in the spring of 1879, he submitted his resignation, receiving a small pension that was his sole income thereafter. He then left Basel and began the nomadic life - moving from boarding-house to boarding-house in search of the right climate and conditions - that he would lead for the decade of active life remaining to him prior to his collapse. It is miraculous that anyone with such severe problems and living such a life could have written anything at all, let alone the series of brilliant books that Nietzsche managed to complete in this period, beginning with the first volume of *Human, All Too Human*. And to all of this must be added the publication history of these books, which compounds the miracle. This history was troubled by Nietzsche's often strained relations with his publishers and printers, and plagued by such other all-too-human difficulties as his eye problems, requiring him to resort to dictation much of the time, and to reliance on the assistance of others to put his manuscripts together, as well as making proof-reading a torment. But worst of all, Nietzsche's

publication history is a veritable chronicle of failure. A recent study by William Schaberg makes all of this painfully clear, setting out the whole long and sorry story in depressing detail.⁴ *The Birth of Tragedy* sold modestly well, and attracted a good deal of attention - even if much of it was hostile. But the same cannot be said of any of Nietzsche's subsequent books, during his sentient lifetime. Prior to his collapse, none of them sold more than a few hundred copies, and few of them attracted any attention whatsoever. *Human, All Too Human* is a vivid case in point. Of the 1,000 copies in the first printing of the original version, only 120 were sold in 1878; and more than half remained unsold in 1886, when Nietzsche reacquired them and repackaged them with a new introduction as the first volume of the two-volume second edition. The supplement he published in 1879 under the subtitle 'Assorted Opinions and Maxims' sold even more poorly: of the 1,000 copies printed, only a third had been sold by 1886. The second supplement *The Wanderer and His Shadow*, published a year later, fared even worse: fewer than 200 of its initial 1,000 copies had been sold by 1886, when Nietzsche acquired the rights to both supplements and republished them with a new introduction, as the second volume of the second edition of *Human, All Too Human*. There was no true reprinting of additional copies until 1893, when another printing of 1,000 copies of the combined work was run; and its xii I N T R O D U C T I O N sales remained slow even after his later works began to receive more attention. *Human, All Too Human* attained greater circulation and availability as part of the editions of his collected works that began to appear after Nietzsche's death; but it was long eclipsed by *The Birth of Tragedy* before it and by *Thus Spoke Zarathustra* and its sequels after it, both in Europe and in the English-speaking world. The same is true of the other two works in Nietzsche's 'free spirit' series, *Daybreak* and *The Gay Science*. The neglect of *Human, All Too Human* in the English-speaking world is at least partly owing to Walter Kaufmann's lack of interest in it. It was through his translations and his widely read study *Nietzsche: Philosopher, Psychologist, Antichrist*, first published in 1950, that many English-speaking readers after World War II became interested in and acquainted with Nietzsche. Kaufmann translated Nietzsche's first book, *The Birth of Tragedy*, and virtually everything Nietzsche published from *The Gay Science* onward; but he never got around to translating any of the things Nietzsche published in the interval, during the crucial period in which he published not only the three instalments of *Human, All Too Human* but also the four *Untimely Meditations* and *Daybreak*, except for brief excerpts which he inserted in other volumes. Indeed, even Kaufmann's translation of *The Gay Science* was something of an afterthought, appearing long after most of his other translations.⁵ Kaufmann can hardly be blamed for having the interests he did, and for the things he did not choose to do; but they had consequences, since there were no other readily available complete

translations of *Human, All Too Human* or *Daybreak* in English until the early 1980s, when Marion Faber translated the first volume of *Human, All Too Human* (published by the University of Nebraska Press) and Hollingdale's Cambridge University Press translations appeared. Their long inaccessibility ensured that these works, and Nietzsche's thinking during the period in which he wrote them, would remain virtually unknown to English-speaking readers during the preceding three decades. (They likewise had been virtually invisible previously, when Nietzsche was known mainly second-hand in the Englishspeaking world, and was commonly assumed to be the proto-Nazi he had been made out to be by Nazi propaganda.) The problem was compounded by Kaufmann's treatment of *Human, All Too Human* (and *Daybreak* and *The Gay Science* as well) in his popular intellectual-biographical study, which had little competition for nearly two decades. This entire period, for Kaufmann, was a gestation period in Nietzsche's thought, of little interest in its own right. He appears to have deemed it deserving of comment at all chiefly for the anticipations to be found in some aphorisms of ideas that became prominent in his later thinking, and for the ammunition other aphorisms afford that were useful in combating Nietzsche's Nazi misinterpretation. So *Human, All Too Human* is relegated to a few pages, in a chapter entitled 'Discovery of the Will to Power'. 'There would be little sense', Kaufmann wrote (without explanation), 'in trying here to sample the gems of *Human, all-too-Human* or [*Daybreak*].' He restricted himself to asserting, with a few illustrations, that, xiii I N T R O D U C T I O N 'Proceeding quite unsystematically and considering each problem on its own merits, without a theory to prove or an axe to grind, Nietzsche reverts now and then to explanations in terms of what he was later to call a will to power.'⁶ The works of this period, for Kaufmann, were of significance primarily as the record of Nietzsche's development from the author of *The Birth of Tragedy* into a psychological thinker on a par with Freud, with his further transformation into a philosopher coming somewhat later. There certainly is some truth in this. *Human, All Too Human* undeniably does show us Nietzsche as psychologist both under development and at work, inventing a kind of psychologizing for which he found a wealth of applications all around him- socially, culturally, behaviourally, intellectually, even philosophically- and simultaneously inventing himself as a new kind of thinker capable of employing this sort of analysis to fascinating and important effect. He was not operating in a void. He had some brilliant aphoristic predecessors, the inspiration of such Enlightenment exemplars as Voltaire, and the benefit of reading his 'educator' and philosophicalpsychological mentor Schopenhauer. He also had the more immediate example and encouragement of his newfound friend Paul Ree, who had just written a book in a somewhat similar spirit entitled *Psychological Observations*. Ree's influence was readily and profusely acknowledged by Nietzsche, who went so far as to say that his own

position at this time could be called 'Reealism'; and it was evident to all who knew him- including the Wagners, who bitterly lamented it (all the more because Ree was Jewish). But the results were much more than the sum of their influences even here. And they also added up to something that was much more than psychology as well. It is true enough that Nietzsche's thinking continued to develop, even from one book to the next in this period, as well as over the course of the next decade; and that, as Kaufmann maintained, Nietzsche's philosophical maturity was yet some time off. Yet his accomplishment in the three instalments of *Human, All Too Human* is remarkable in its own right, and can stand on its own feet. If he had died without publishing another thing (as might very well have happened), it would have been sufficient to earn him an important place in the intellectual history of the past several centuries - even if a somewhat different one than he has come to have. The gulf that separates this work from Nietzsche's previous published writings is wide. The enthusiasms, aspirations and assumptions that so strikingly pervade and animate his earlier work are no longer in evidence. It is a much more sober and analytical, colder and wiser thinker who is at work here. Its author is still hopeful of finding both a diagnosis and a cure to what ails our culture and threatens its future, and resists Schopenhauer's pessimism; but he is as disillusioned now with Wagner, the new Reich and other pined pipers of modern times as he earlier had been with traditional religious consolations and their philosophical cousins. He has become convinced that only something like a continuation and radicalization of Enlightenment thinking, getting to the bottom of things and ruthlessly exposing all false hopes and dangerous palliatives, can afford us at least the possibility of a future worth having and a life worth living. Nietzsche's xiv INTRODUCTION dedication to Voltaire was more than a slap at Wagner (although that it surely was). It also was the announcement of a major intellectual reorientation, placing him squarely in the often calurnnied but courageous tradition of Enlightenment thought and effort. For the Nietzsche of *Human, All Too Human* nothing is beyond criticism and there is a strong suspicion that (as he would later put it) all 'idols' of our reverence will turn out to be hollow and all-too-human when subjected to critical scrutiny. His new 'psychological' tools are brought to bear upon them, with results that amply support this suspicion. But there is more to the outlook and way of thinking that he is devising and putting into practice here than this. In 'On Truth and Lies in a Nonmoral Sense', some five years earlier, Nietzsche had begun sketching a fundamentally and severely naturalistic picture of our general human condition, in a world over which no benevolent deity reigns and in which no beneficent rationality is at work. We are depicted as alone and adrift in a godless universe, a mere cosmic accident, ill-equipped either to comprehend what is going on or to do much about it; and we are kidding ourselves if we think otherwise - although we seem almost irresistibly drawn to

do so. Can we live without such illusions? Nietzsche was at first inclined to doubt it-as one sees in *The Birth of Tragedy*, written at about the same time. By the time of *Human, All Too Human*, he seems to have resolved to try. The power of myths and illusions to sustain anyone possessed of an uncompromising intellectual conscience is undermined when one sees through them; and so one may have little other choice, if - as for Nietzsche - Kierkegaardian leaps of faith are out of the question, and a Schopenhauerian negation of life is repellent. *Human, All Too Human* is a work of cold passion, in which nothing more is assumed about our humanity than the picture sketched in the 'Truth and Lies' essay, and in which everything in human life that might seem to be of loftier origins is called before the tribunal of scrutiny, with humbling results. Yet the spirit of the investigation is profoundly and pervasively affirmative; for the passion that drives it is not only that of an honesty that will tolerate no nonsense or groundless wishful thinking, but also of a desperate search for enough to work with and ways of doing so to sustain ourselves despite all. To call this 'secular humanism' would be to sell it short; for while Nietzsche's outlook is radically secular, he is far from taking humanity either in general or as embodied in each and every one of us to be the locus of meaning and value. But it is a kind of toughminded and yet doggedly affirmative naturalism, the upshot of which is that our all-too-human humanity leaves a good deal to be desired, and yet gives us something to work with that is not to be despised. But if we are to make something worthwhile of ourselves, we have to take a good hard look at ourselves. And this, for Nietzsche, means many things. It means looking at ourselves in the light of everything we can learn about the world and ourselves from the natural sciences - most emphatically including evolutionary biology, physiology and even medical science. It also means looking at ourselves in the light of everything we can learn about human life from history, from the social sciences, from the study of arts, *X V I N T R O D U C T I O N* religions, languages, literatures, mores and other features of various cultures. It further means attending closely to human conduct on different levels of human interaction, to the relation between what people say and seem to think about themselves and what they do, to their reactions in different sorts of situations, and to everything else about them that affords clues to what makes them tick. All of this, and more, is what Nietzsche is up to in *Human, All Too Human*. He is at once developing and employing the various perspectival techniques that seem to him to be relevant to the understanding of what we have come to be and what we have it in us to become. This involves gathering materials for a reinterpretation and reassessment of human life, making tentative efforts along those lines and then trying them out on other human phenomena both to put them to the test and to see what further light can be shed by doing so. This multi-perspectival and multi-directional method, which Nietzsche employed with increasing dexterity and

ingenuity throughout the remainder of his productive life, finds its first extended trials and applications in *Human, All Too Human*. The results are uneven, as one might expect- and indeed as is always the case in Nietzsche's writings (or, for that matter, in the case of anyone who engages in such a complex, uncertain and adventuresome sort of interpretive enterprise). Distinguishing between genuine insights and personal preferences, prejudices, over-generalizations, irresistible puns and other such inspirations is not easy. It often can be done better by others than by oneself - even if one's intellectual conscience is as alert and vigorous as Nietzsche's, to whom the *all-too-human* was no stranger. But by precept and example he invites us to subject him to the same sort of scrutiny to which he subjects others; and that is something many will want to do. He only asks that one be prepared to have one's very objections subjected in turn to the same searching critical assessment- for they too may be questionable. Nietzsche himself looked back on *Human, All Too Human* twice in print. The final time was in his rather creatively and grandiosely self-interpretive *Ecce Homo*, in 1888, in the course of a review of all of his main publications under the characteristically immodest heading 'Why I Write Such Good Books'. The occasion of his first subsequent retrospective- the reissuing of all three instalments together in 1886- may itself have had its *all-too-human* motivations (not the least of which was Nietzsche's hope that by repackaging them with new prefaces he might be able to sell more of them and attract more attention to them). Nonetheless, the two new prefaces he wrote on this occasion are of no little interest; and it is important for readers to bear in mind that they were written long after the material they precede- eight years after the first volume, and six and seven years after the two parts of the second volume. Indeed, the prefaces themselves were written at different times and places - the former in Nice, on the French Mediterranean coast in Spring 1886, and the latter in Sils Maria, in the mountainous Swiss Engadine region, in September of that year. They both deserve close reading, both before and after one has made one's way through the maze of the 1,400 aphorisms.

xvi I N T R O D U C T I O N In the first preface Nietzsche sees himself at the time of the first volume as already burdened with the large and heavy questions that compelled him toward philosophy, and also as struggling to achieve the intellectual and spiritual freedom and resources needed to deal with them, which he feels he had lacked in sufficient measure previously. He also sees himself as having been in a precarious state of health both physically and intellectually, slowly convalescing from the maladies of both sorts that had threatened to engulf him. The same theme is sounded again in the second preface; and there he makes it even clearer what the chief dangers were to which he had to develop resistance and learn to overcome. He refers to these writings as 'a continuation and redoubling of a spiritual cure, namely of the anti-romantic self-treatment that my still healthy

instinct had itself discovered and prescribed for me against a temporary attack of the most dangerous form of romanticism', and as the expressions of a 'courageous pessimism' that is the 'antithesis of all romantic mendacity' (u:P:2, 4). As Nietzsche observes in the first preface, his determination to resist and reject all such temptations (which for him could be summed up in a single name: Wagner) was still immature here, and was not yet 'that mature freedom of spirit which is equally self-mastery and discipline of the heart and permits access to many and contradictory modes of thought', and which he evidently feels he subsequently had come to attain (1: P: 4). But he sees himself in *Human, All Too Human* as having been on the way to it. And it is of no little importance to the understanding of Nietzsche both to observe that he not only places this interpretation upon the direction and outcome of his own intellectual development, and to recognize what is fundamental to it: the repudiation of 'all romantic mendacity', and its replacement by the cultivation of the intellectual conscience and analytical, critical and interpretive abilities of the 'free spirit' he was attempting to become and conjure among his readers by his own example. Nietzsche thus saw himself here as having turned away from the Wagnerian-Schopenhauerian Romanticism of *The Birth of Tragedy* (of which he was explicitly critical along these very lines in a new preface to that work also written in 1886, entitled 'Attempt at a Self-Criticism'). In doing so, and partly as a way of doing so, he had turned with all the self-discipline and intellect he could muster in an analytical direction, replacing art with science as his new paradigm of high spirituality. Thus, in the preface to the second volume, he refers to the various instalments of *Human, All Too Human* as 'precepts of health that may be recommended to the more spiritual natures of the generation just coming up as a disciplina voluntatis [discipline of the will]' (n:P:2). It is a discipline as much needed today as it was needed by Nietzsche himself and by 'the generation just coming up' in his own time. This in part answers the question of the intended audience of these volumes. Nietzsche did not think of himself, either at this time or later, as writing primarily for professional philosophers, or even for students in philosophy courses. He clearly was moving in what he conceived to be a philosophical direction; but he was writing first and foremost for inquiring and adventuresome minds of sufficient sophistication to keep pace with him, xvii I N T R O D U C T I O N whoever and wherever they may be- not only in academia but also among the intelligent reading public. He hoped in particular to be able to reach the better minds of the younger generation, who might be more receptive than their elders to challenges to preconceived ideas and assumed values. Yet he also had hopes of having the sort of wider impact Voltaire and other firebrands of the Enlightenment had had a century earlier. At the same time Nietzsche worried about what the likes of the Wagners and the few colleagues who had not given up on him would think of it. For a time he even considered publishing the first

volume anonymously or under a pseudonym. *Human, All Too Human* may not seem to us today to be scandalously radical, however provocative it may be on some topics; but at the time Nietzsche rightly feared that it would be deeply offensive to many of its readers - not in the ways *The Birth of Tragedy* had been to his fellow philologists, but in an almost opposite way. Now it was those who had been enamoured of Nietzsche the romantic who were offended, by his abandonment of Romanticism in favour of a coldly and severely analytical Naturalism- for which he sought the widest possible audience. Beyond the circle of those who already knew of him, however, Nietzsche need not have worried about the scandalousness of his new venture - for, to his dismay, no one else paid the slightest attention. Even today, few recognize it as the gold mine it is, not only as an excellent way of becoming acquainted with his thinking, but also for its wealth of ideas worth thinking about. It does not do full justice to these ideas to characterize them as 'psychological', let alone as revolving around the 'discovery of the will to power' (as Kaufmann suggests). Nietzsche himself, in his 1886 preface to the first volume, observes that although he may not have realized it at the time, it eventually dawned upon him that 'it is the problem of order of rank' - that is, the problem of values and their revaluation and ordering- 'of which we may say it is our problem'; and that, to position themselves to address this problem adequately, 'we free spirits' first have to become 'adventurers and circumnavigators of that inner world called "man", as surveyors and [measurers] of that "higher" and "one [above] the other" that is likewise called "man"- penetrating everywhere, almost[!] without fear, disdaining nothing, losing nothing, asking everything, cleansing everything of what is chance and accident in it and as it were thoroughly sifting it . . . ' (1:P). That is a fair characterization of what Nietzsche does in *Human, All Too Human*; and it is in that sense that the term 'psychological' applies to his task and way of going about it. 'Psychology' in his time, after all, was not a discipline in its own right, separate and distinct from philosophy, but rather was conceived both loosely and strictly as a part of it; and in Nietzsche's hands it retained this intimate connection with philosophy as he came to understand and practice it. Philosophy for him revolves around the exploration of things human, and is first and foremost the attempt to comprehend them - even if that comprehension is not an end in itself. It prepares the way for the further comprehension of the whole complex matter of value, as it relates to issues of quality and worth in and about human life, in the service of its enhancement. In *Human, All Too Human* xviii I N T R O D U C T I O N Nietzsche took (and in his prefaces saw himself as taking) major steps in that direction. He had yet to learn to temper his new enthusiasm for the natural sciences, to figure out how to revisit the perspectives relating to the arts and culture he had known so well without becoming captive once again to them, to supplement both with yet others and to develop the ability to make larger

interpretive sense of our humanity in the light of this multiplicity of perspectives upon it. But he was on his way. This assessment of the place of *Human, All Too Human* in the context of Nietzsche's larger intellectual development has the virtues of acknowledging the great differences between it (and its companion volumes in the 'free spirit' series) and his earlier writings, and also of coherently relating his later writings to both. Many readers - and interpreters - make the mistake of regarding these 'free spirit' works as a kind of interlude between *The Birth of Tragedy* and *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*, and of reading them- if at all- from the perspective of his later writings, in relation to which they are generally found to pale by comparison, both rhetorically and philosophically. It would make a good deal more sense to view his later writings in the perspective of his 'free spirit' works, taking *Human, All Too Human* as one's point of departure, and regarding *Zarathustra* as an interlude between the last of them (the first four-part version of *The Gay Science*) and the continuation of Nietzsche's aphoristic works, beginning with *Beyond Good and Evil* and the expanded version of *The Gay Science* he published a year later. For the continuities between them are strong, even if Nietzsche's arsenal of perspectives grows, his philosophical sophistication increases, his rhetoric sharpens and heats up, and his intellectual pendulum swings back from its scientifically-oriented extreme point in the direction of his artistic and cultural concerns and sensibility (moving subsequently in considerably shorter arcs in the general vicinity of the centre of the spectrum they mark out). This even applies to the organization of *Human, All Too Human* and the two later works that are not devoted to specific topics or figures, *Beyond Good and Evil* and *Twilight of the Idols*. Like both of them, the first version of *Human, All Too Human* does have an organization, in the form of the division of the volume into parts with headings. Interestingly enough, all three have the same number of major parts - nine - plus an epilogue. And there is a striking similarity among the headings as well. Each starts out with sections on topics relating to philosophers and philosophy; each has a section relating to morality, and another to religious and metaphysical matters; each has a section on social and political matters, and another on cultural and intellectual topics; and each, at some point, contains a collection of oneliners on a variety of sensitive topics guaranteed to offend almost everyone. To be sure, the parallels are not exact; but they are close enough to warrant the suggestion of a continuity of form - and in content there are not only significant differences but also remarkable similarities. One might well ask oneself in what ways Nietzsche's thinking changed on these matters from his initial discussions of them in *Human, All Too Human* to *Beyond Good and Evil* to *Twilight*, what his reasons may have been (if he does not make them explicit)- and whether the changes were invariably for the better.

xix INTRODUCTION

The two parts of the second volume of *Human, All Too Human* were not supplied with the same sorts of

headings, or indeed with any subheadings at all. Most of the aphorisms in them can easily be assigned to one or another of those Nietzsche uses in the first volume, however; for they chiefly range over and fall into the same general topics. An examination of the list of these topics makes it clear both that *Human, All Too Human* is far from being as formless as it is often taken to be, and also that Nietzsche's interests include but are not restricted to issues that are normally deemed 'philosophical'. The first (appropriately enough), 'Of First and Last Things', deals with metaphysical thinking - but in a curiously detached sort of way, more as a phenomenon to be understood than a set of arguments to be engaged head on. The same sort of approach is taken to morality in the second ('On the History of Moral Sensations'- Nietzsche's first go at what he came to call the 'genealogy of morals'); to religion in the third ('The Religious Life'); and to art in the fourth ('From the Souls of Artists and Writers'). In each case Nietzsche is proposing that we make the experiment of looking at these seemingly sublime things as human phenomena- experiences and activities of human beings- asking what is going on when such things occur in human life, and shifting the presumption from their sublimity to the suspicion that their appearance of sublimity may well be deceiving. In the next four sections Nietzsche turns his attention to the domain of cultural, social and interpersonal relationships and types. There is more to culture than art and literature; and he attempts to bring it into focus in the fifth section ('Tokens of Higher and Lower Culture'). Social institutions and relationships are the logical next stop, in the sixth section ('Man in Society'), with family matters coming next ('Woman and Child'), followed by political life ('A Glance at the State'). If in the first four sections he surveys things that claim some sort of transcendent significance, of the sort Hegel sought to express in his characterization of their domain as that of 'absolute spirituality', here Nietzsche surveys those things that flesh out what Hegel had called 'the life of a people' on the level of its 'objective spirituality'. These too are among the chief sorts of things in terms of which our humanity and human meaning and worth are commonly conceived. If one asks what it is that sets us apart from and above other creatures whose existence is merely animal, and is not permitted to give a quick religious or metaphysical answer appealing to transcendent principles and powers, this is a fair inventory of possible answers. That is the larger (and genuinely if unconventionally philosophical) point of these collections of reflections, many of which might not appear to have any philosophical significance whatsoever. In the final section Nietzsche turns to what he considers to be left after one has considered all of these other dimensions of human life: what we are or can be on our own, as individuals, within or by ourselves ('Man Alone with Himself'). Later he would add another item to the first four on the list, belonging with them, but not yet as problematical in his eyes as he subsequently recognized it to be: scientific thinking, of the very

sort he had become so enamoured of and reliant upon here. Like the glasses with which one may be provided to deal with vision problems, and to which one may become so XX I N T R O D U C T I O N accustomed that one ceases to be aware of them, this sort of thinking can come to be taken for granted beyond the point to which reliance upon it is warranted. To his great credit, Nietzsche was far quicker than most to become sensitive to the limitations of ways of thinking to which he was attracted - and then, having done so, to get past his disappointment with them and ascertain the best uses that might be made of them, their limitations notwithstanding. In *Human, All Too Human*, however, his romance with the sciences was still young, and this process had yet to run its course. The expression Nietzsche adopted to characterize the kind of thinker and human being he conceived himself to have become '- or at any rate to have been on the way to becoming- at the time of *Human, All Too Human* is that which he features in its subtitle: 'free spirit', *Freigeist*. *Human, All Too Human* is proclaimed in its subtitle to be 'A Book for Free Spirits'. Three years after the publication of its first instalment, when Nietzsche published the first version of *The Gay Science*, he had the following printed on the back cover: 'This book marks the conclusion of a series of writings by FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE whose common goal it is to erect a new image and ideal of the free spirit.' He then went on to list *Human, All Too Human* and its supplements and sequels up to and including *The Gay Science*? But this did not mark the end of Nietzsche's attachment to the idea of the 'free spirit'. It reappears very significantly in *Beyond Good and Evil*, as the heading of the second part of the book in which, following his largely critical first part 'On the Prejudices of Philosophers', he proceeds to set forth a variety of his own ideas on a broad range of philosophical issues. And it reappears again not only in his retrospective *Ecce Homo*, as one would expect, but also in *Twilight of the Idols*, in a section bearing the heading 'My conception of freedom'.⁸ From first to last it is invoked to convey the double meaning of both liberation from things that have tended to hinder and hobble one, and of determination to undertake tasks requiring independence, strength, courage and imagination. Nietzschean free spirits are not necessarily philosophers; but Nietzschean philosophers are necessarily free spirits. Voltaire, for Nietzsche, was an exemplary free spirit, as the original dedication of *Human, All Too Human* indicated: 'To Voltaire's memory, in commemoration of the day of his death, 30 May q.' His example would appear to have taught Nietzsche the erstwhile devoted disciple of Wagner something he came to realize he badly needed to learn. The 'free spirit' is 'a spirit that has become free', as Nietzsche emphasizes in his remarks on *Human, All Too Human* in *Ecce Homo*. In the things that matter most, Rousseau was both right and wrong - right in observing that people are 'everywhere in chains', but wrong in supposing them to be 'born free'. True freedom of the spirit is something that is acquired-if at all- with difficulty, and

only by a few. Indeed, in Nietzsche's 1886 preface to the first volume he even goes so far as to allow that he was obliged to invent the 'free spirits' to whom the book is addressed, since " 'free spirits' of this kind do not exist, did not exist' - although he says 'I had need of them', all the more so because he lacked the kind of actual companionship and comradeship that people of this sort could provide. 'That free spirits of this kind could one xxi I N T R O D U C T I O N day exist', on the other hand, and indeed that they will one day exist, he does not doubt. 'I see them already coming', he optimistically asserts (1: P: 2); and in any event the statement on the back cover of *The Gay Science* makes it clear enough that he hoped and intended *Human, All Too Human* to speed the day, by both precept and example. But the same could be said for all of Nietzsche's aphoristic works, after as well as before *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*. It is perhaps less true of *Zarathustra* itself, despite *Zarathustra's* repeated proclamations that he wants no disciples and wants his companions to think for themselves; for it is hard (though not impossible) to read and experience *Zarathustra* as a nontendentious work. And it likewise is perhaps less true of Nietzsche's polemical later works- against Wagner, against Christianity and even (in *On the Genealogy of Morals*) against the kind of morality he considered to have come to prevail in the Western world. Polemics may have their place in the liberation of fettered spirits from the shackles that bind them, and so in making it possible for some people who might not otherwise do so to become free spirits; but they are far from sufficient to complete the process, and can easily subvert it- as the responses of many people to what they find in some of Nietzsche illustrate well enough. Unfortunately for Nietzsche's reception, his free-spirited side has all too often been overshadowed and even eclipsed by the appearance of a much more impassioned and seemingly dogmatic side, frightening some and exciting others - for equally dubious reasons in either case. Neither the fact that this appearance has been seen in markedly different (and incompatible) ways, nor the objection that it is only an appearance rather than the dark side of the reality of his thought, has sufficed to keep it from long impeding his interpretation and assessment. The best remedy for this predicament is to direct attention to those works in which Nietzsche is engaged in his freespirted labours, from *Human, All Too Human* to *The Gay Science* and *Beyond Good and Evil* to *Twilight of the Idols*. This is not to expurgate him; for there is plenty in each of these books to worry about and argue with, and much that is all-too-human in him no less than in his targets. But in these volumes he for the most part carries on in the manner of the kind of 'free spirit' he seeks to evoke and encourage. If one would understand the sort of thing he has in mind in speaking of philosophers and philosophy of the future as he would have them be, one would do well to begin - as he did - with this idea in mind, as the presupposition of anything further that a Nietzschean kind of philosophy might involve. There is no better commentary in Nietzsche on what free-spiritedness

meant to him, as the idea took shape in and beyond *Human, All Too Human*, than the paragraph with which he concludes the part of *Beyond Good and Evil* entitled 'The Free Spirit'. It deserves to be read together with the prefaces to the two volumes of *Human, All Too Human* he shortly went on to write. With them in mind one can turn to *Human, All Too Human* itself and see why Nietzsche was not content to allow it to go unnoticed even after he had gone on to publish a good many other things - and why there may be no better introduction to his thought and thinking. xxii

I N T R O D U C T I O N

At home, or at least having been guests, in many countries of the spirit; having escaped again and again from the musty agreeable nooks into which preference and prejudice, youth, origin, the accidents of people and books or even exhaustion from wandering seemed to have banished us; full of malice against the lures of dependence that lie hidden in honors, or money, or offices, or enthusiasms of the senses; grateful even to need and vacillating sickness because they always rid us from some rule and its 'prejudice,' grateful to god, devil, sheep, and worm in us; curious to a vice, investigators to the point of cruelty, with uninhibited fingers for the unfathomable, with teeth and stomachs for the most indigestible, ready for every feat that requires a sense of acuteness and acute senses, ready for every venture, thanks to an excess of 'free will,' with fore- and back-souls into whose ultimate intentions nobody can look so easily, with fore- and backgrounds which no foot is likely to explore to the end; concealed under cloaks of light, conquerors even if we look like heirs and prodigals, arrangers and collectors from morning till late, misers of our riches and our crammed drawers, economical in learning and forgetting, inventive in schemas, occasionally proud of tables of categories, occasionally pedants, occasionally night owls of work even in broad daylight; yes, when it is necessary even scarecrows - and today it is necessary; namely, insofar as we are born, sworn, jealous friends of solitude, of our own most profound, most midnightly, most middaily solitude; that is the type of man we are, we free spirits! And perhaps you have something of this, too, you that are coming? you new philosophers?

-9 Notes

1 On the Genealogy of *Morals/Ecce Homo*, trans. Walter Kaufmann (New York, 1967), p. 283 ('Why I Write Such Good Books': *Human, All Too Human*, §71).

2 See, e.g., *The Gay Science*, trans. Walter Kaufmann (New York, 1974), §§108, 125 and 343.

3 *Ecce Homo*, p. 283

4 *The Nietzsche Canon: A Publication History and Bibliography* (Chicago, 1995).

5 In 1974 (see note 2).

6 Walter Kaufmann, *Nietzsche: Philosopher, Psychologist, Antichrist*, 4th edn. (Princeton, 1974), pp. 157, 158.

7 *The Gay Science*, trans. Kaufmann, p. 30.

8 *Twilight of the Idols*, in *The Portable Nietzsche*, ed. and trans. Walter Kaufmann (New York, 1954), 'Skirmishes of an Untimely Man', §39.

9 Trans. Walter Kaufmann (New York, 1966), §44. xxiii

CHRONOLOGY

Friedrich Wilhelm Nietzsche born on 15 October in Rocken, in the Prussian province of Saxony His father dies (at the age of 36) Attends the

classics-oriented boarding-school Schulpforta; plays the piano and composes
Enters Bonn University to study classical languages and literatures Associate
professor of classical philology (before even completing his Ph.D.) at the Swiss
university at Basel Full professor at Basel; enlists as a medical orderly in the
Franco Prussian War, contracting serious illnesses First book *The Birth of
Tragedy* appears (and is met with scholarly derision)- his only major classical
studies publication Publishes the first three *Untimely Meditations*, including the
essays *On the Uses and Disadvantages of History for Life* and *Schopenhauer as
Educator* Writes a fourth *Meditation* in homage to Wagner, but his enthusiasm for
Wagner cools The first volume of *Human, All Too Human* (638 aphorisms)
appears; Wagner sends him *Parsifal*, and their estrangement deepens Resigns
(with pension) from his position at Basel, incapacitated by health problems;
begins spending his summers in the Swiss Engadine region, and his winters in
northern Italy, living in boarding-houses Writes two sequels to *Human, All Too
Human*, subsequently published as the two parts of its second volume (another
758 aphorisms) Publishes *Daybreak* (575 aphorisms); alternative periods of
depression and exhilaration; first summer in Sils Maria, where the idea of 'eternal
recurrence' comes to him The year of his intense but short-lived relationship with
Lou Salome, which ends badly; publishes the initial four-part version of *The Gay
Science* (342 aphorisms and reflections) The first two parts of *Thus Spoke
Zarathustra* are written and published; estrangement from family and friends;
depression; resolves against living in Germany; Wagner dies xxiv C H R O N O L
O G Y Completes and publishes the third part of *Zarathustra*; breaks with his
sister Elizabeth, unable to endure her anti-Semitic, pro Teutonic' fiancée Bernard
Forster (She marries him the next year, to Nietzsche's disgust and distress,
accompanying him to Paraguay where he sought to found a Teutonic colony) The
fourth part of *Zarathustra* is written, but is only privately printed and circulated;
condition worsens *Beyond Good and Evil* (296 aphorisms and reflections in nine
parts, plus a poem 'Aftersong') is published; new editions of most pre
Zarathustra works are prepared and supplied with prefaces 1886---7 An
expanded second edition of *The Gay Science* is prepared and published, with a
new preface and fifth part consisting of 41 additional reflections, and an
appendix of poetry', 'Songs of Prince Vogelfrei' *On the Genealogy of Morals*
appears, consisting of a preface and three 'essays' (of 17, 25 and 28 numbered
sections, respectively); completes orchestral score for *Hymnus an das Leben*;
begins working on *magnus opus*, to be called *The Will to Power* The Case of
Wagner is published; and *Twilight of the Idols*, *The Antichrist*, Nietzsche contra
Wagner, *Dionysian Dithyrambs* (a collection of poems) and *Ecce Homo* are all
written; *The Will to Power* project is dropped, in favour of a projected four-part
Revaluation of All Values; condition deteriorates Collapses in early January in
Turin, at the age of 44 (never recovers, living his final eleven years in invalid

insanity in the care of his mother and sister); *Twilight of the Idols* is published in January First public edition of the fourth part of *Zarathustra* appears Sister returns from Paraguay, and - under the name Elizabeth Forster-Nietzsche- assists their mother in the management of her brother's affairs *The Antichrist* and *Nietzsche Contra Wagner* are published Mother dies, leaving complete control of his care - and of his literary estate- to Elizabeth, who exploits his growing fame and fosters the assimilation of his thought to right-extremist political purposes during the next four decades H)OO Nietzsche dies, on 25 August, in Weimar 1')01 Sister publishes an arrangement of selections from his notebooks of 1883--8 under the title *The Will to Power*, and in his name 1')08 *Ecce Homo* is finally published 191Q-11 First edition of Nietzsche's collected works is published under the supervision of Elizabeth - including a greatly expanded edition of *The Will to Power* R.S. XXV FURTHER READING Intellectual background The history of philosophy has few chapters as rich and varied as that of German (or Central European) philosophy from Kant to Nietzsche. A superb survey of German philosophy up to and including Kant is Lewis White Beck's *Early German Philosophy: Kant and his Predecessors* (Cambridge, MA, 1969). The next chapters of the story are well told by Frederick C. Beiser in *The Fate of Reason: German Philosophy from Kant to Fichte* (Cambridge, MA, 1987); G. A. Kelly in *Idealism, Politics and History: Sources of Hegelian Thought* (Cambridge, 1969) and Herbert Schnadelbach in *Philosophy in Germany 1831-1933* (Cambridge, 1984). Two classic studies of German philosophy in the nineteenth century, both first published in 1941, are Herbert Marcuse's *Reason and Revolution: Hegel and the Rise of Social Theory* (Boston, 1960) and Karl Lowith's *From Hegel to Nietzsche: The Revolution in Nineteenth-Century Thought* (New York, 1964). More recent studies include Walter Kaufmann's *From Shakespeare to Existentialism* (Garden City, NY, 1959), Maurice Mandelbaum's *History, Man and Reason* (Baltimore, 1971), and Robert Solomon's *From Rationalism to Existentialism* (New York, 1972). The two most important figures in Nietzsche's intellectual life and development were Arthur Schopenhauer and Richard Wagner. Useful studies of Schopenhauer include Patrick Gardiner's *Schopenhauer* (Baltimore, 1963), D. W. Hamlyn's *Schopenhauer* (London, 1980) and Christopher Janaway's *Self and World in Schopenhauer* (Oxford, 1989). On Wagner, see Ernest Newman's four-volume biography *The Life of Richard Wagner* (New York, 1933-46), and Geoffrey Skelton's *Wagner at Bayreuth* (London and New York, 1976). The many studies of the Nietzsche-Wagner relationship include Dietrich Fischer-Dieskau's *Wagner and Nietzsche* (New York, 1976) and Frederick Love's *The Young Nietzsche and the Wagnerian Experience* (Chapel Hill, 1963). Roger Hollinrake discusses all three of them in *Nietzsche, Wagner and the Philosophy of Pessimism* (London, 1982). Nietzsche himself published essays on both Schopenhauer and Wagner,

shortly before *Human, All Too Human*, although they both reveal much more about the Nietzsche of that period of his life than they do about Schopenhauer and Wagner themselves. They are the third and fourth of his *Untimely Meditations* (Cambridge, 1983), and bear the titles 'Schopenhauer as Educator' and 'Richard Wagner in Bayreuth'. Late in his productive life xxvi F U R T H E R R E A D I N G (though only fifteen years after the appearance of the latter essay), Nietzsche also published two short books as polemically critical of Wagner as his early essay had been appreciative: *The Case of Wagner* (New York, 1967) and *Nietzsche Contra Wagner*, included in Walter Kaufmann's *The Portable Nietzsche* (New York, 1954). Nietzsche's life Perhaps the best recent biography of Nietzsche is Ronald Hayman's *Nietzsche: A Critical Life* (New York, 1980). Another useful and shorter biography is R. J. Hollingdale's *Nietzsche* (London, 1965). Kaufmann's *Nietzsche: Philosopher, Psychologist, Antichrist* (Princeton, 1950; Princeton, 1974), a kind of intellectual biography, is the book that rehabilitated Nietzsche for the post-World War II generation in the English-speaking world, and remains one of the most accessible introductions to his life and thought. Here again, Nietzsche himself has also supplied a contribution that cannot go unmentioned, even if it is no more reliable and no less tendentious than his writings on Schopenhauer and Wagner. It is his intellectualautobiographical *Ecce Homo* (New York, 1967), to which he gave the subtitle 'How One Becomes What One Is'. It is the last book he completed before his collapse. Considered by some to be all too clearly indicative of his incipient insanity, it is regarded by others as a work of profound significance. In any event, it is well worth reading. Nietzsche's writings Most of Nietzsche's publications have been translated into English in a number of versions, the best of which have long been generally considered to be the translations made by Walter Kaufmann and R. J. Hollingdale (sometimes in collaboration). A monumental critical edition of his writings in German has been published by De Gruyter, edited by Giorgio Colli and Mazzino Montinari; and a translation project intended to result in an English-language counterpart has now begun, under the editorship of Ernst Behler, at Stanford University Press. Other writings of Nietzsche's that will be of particular interest to readers of the present work certainly include the two similar works following it in what Nietzsche came to think of and refer to as his 'free spirit' series: *Daybreak: Thoughts on the Prejudices of Morality* (Cambridge, 1982), also translated by Hollingdale; and *The Gay Science* (New York, 1974), translated by Kaufmann. Nietzsche's earlier writings are well worth consulting as well, for the indications they provide of the concerns which shaped the direction of his thinking and efforts in this series of aphoristic volumes. Chief among them are his first book (1872), *The Birth of Tragedy* (New York, 1967), translated by Kaufmann, and a series of four essays (first published in the years 1873-6) Nietzsche gathered together in 1886 under the title *Untimely Meditations*

(Cambridge, 1983), translated by Hollingdale. They also include xxvii F U R T H E R R E A D I N G a draft of a n important early essay Nietzsche never finished or published, which however reveals the starkly naturalistic picture of the human condition that was a part of his point of departure: 'On Truth and Lies in a Nonmoral Sense' (1873), translated by Daniel Breazeale and included in his volume Nietzsche, Philosophy and Truth (Atlantic Highlands, NJ, 1979). Following his 'free spirit' series, Nietzsche turned his attention to a very different sort of project: his extraordinary four-part literary-philosophical experiment and masterpiece, Thus Spoke Zarathustra (1883-5), translated (among others) by both Kaufmann (in The Portable Nietzsche) and Hollingdale (Harmondsworth, 1961). He then (1886) returned to the publication of volumes of a somewhat aphoristic nature, beginning with Beyond Good and Evil, which again has been translated by both Kaufmann (New York, 1966) and Hollingdale (Harmondsworth, 1973), and an expanded version of The Gay Science. His next book, On the Genealogy of Morals (1887), translated by Kaufmann and Hollingdale together (New York, 1967), joins his aphoristic style to a three-essay format with a more specific focus than any of his previous aphoristic works (published in 1994, trans. Carol Diethe, edited by Keith Ansell-Pierson). In the final year before his collapse (1888) Nietzsche not only published the two polemics against Wagner and the autobiographical Ecce Homo mentioned above, but also a polemical critique of Christianity, The Antichrist, and a final volume of aphorisms more in the tradition of Human, All Too Human, which (parodying Wagner's fourth Ring opera) he called Gotzendiimmerung, or Twilight of the Idols. Both of these last works have been translated by Kaufmann (in The Portable Nietzsche) and also by Hollingdale (Harmondsworth, 1988). Which of these many things should one read after Human, All Too Human? That depends upon one's interests. If one is primarily interested in matters relating to morality, one might look first at Daybreak, then at the fifth and ninth parts of Beyond Good and Evil and then at On the Genealogy of Morals. On religion, Daybreak again is a good sequel, together with the sections of The Gay Science dealing with God and religion, the third part of Beyond Good and Evil and The Antichrist. On the many philosophical topics relating to knowledge, our world and ourselves, one might look back to the early essay 'On Truth and Lies', and ahead to The Gay Science, the first two parts of Beyond Good and Evil and Twilight of the Idols; and one might also take a look at the selections from Nietzsche's notebooks from the 1880s published under the title The Will to Power, translated by Kaufmann and Hollingdale (New York, 1967). And for an indication of Nietzsche's thinking with respect to the enhancement of life and the possibility of a 'higher humanity' he discerns along with the 'all too human' tendencies he examines here and subsequently, one might look back to his essay 'Schopenhauer as Educator' (the third of his Untimely Meditations) as well as to Thus Spoke Zarathustra.

Nietzsche's thought Nietzsche has been so influential in so many ways during the course of the twentieth century, and has been so variously interpreted; that no one xxviii F U R T H E R R E A D I N G account can be considered authoritative. He has been claimed as originator, anticipator, inspiration and kindred spirit by fascists and humanists, existentialists and deconstructionists, critical theorists and analytical philosophers, and by more artists, writers and composers than any other figure in the history of philosophy (at least since Plato). Both his admirers and his critics can make persuasive arguments for and against him; but they all too often fail to take the trouble to read him thoroughly and attentively enough to understand him - or at any rate to earn the right to make their claims. Walter Kaufmann's classic study Nietzsche (mentioned above) offers a readable interpretation of Nietzsche's thought along humanistic existentialist and pragmatist lines. Another early study of enduring value, which explores Nietzsche's thought more systematically, is George Morgan's What Nietzsche Means (Cambridge, MA, 1941; New York, 1965). Useful interpretations in the analytic tradition include Arthur Danto's Nietzsche as Philosopher (New York, 1965), Alexander Nehamas's Nietzsche: Life as Literature (Cambridge, MA, 1985), Maudemarie Clark's Nietzsche on Truth and Philosophy (Cambridge, 1990), and Richard Schacht's Nietzsche (London and New York, 1983) and Making Sense of Nietzsche (Urbana and Chicago, 1995). A sampling of interpretations along post-structuralist and deconstructionist lines may be found in David Allison's collection The New Nietzsche: Contemporary Styles of Interpretation (New York, 1977). Helpful recent studies of various aspects of Nietzsche's thought relating to matters he discusses in Human, All Too Human include Erich Heller's The Importance of Nietzsche (Chicago, 1988), Peter Bergmann's Nietzsche: The Last Antipolitical German (Bloomington, IN, 1987) and Lester Hunt's Nietzsche and the Origin of Virtue (London, 1991). R.S. xxix

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T H E R E L I G I O U S L I F E 6 0 4 F R O M T H E S O U L S O F A R T I S T S A N D W R I T E R S 8 0 5 T O K E N S O F H I G H E R A N D L O W E R C U L T U R E 1 0 7 6 M A N I N S O C I E T Y 1 3 6 7 W O M A N A N D C H I L D 1 5 0 8 A G L A N C E A T T H E S T A T E 1 6 1 9 M A N A L O N E W I T H H I M S E L F 1 7 9 A M O N G F R I E N D S : A N E P I L O G U E 2 0 5

PREFACE I have been told often enough, and always with an expression of great surprise, that all my writings, from the Birth of Tragedy* to the most recently published Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future, have something that distinguishes them and unites them together: they all of them, I have been given to understand, contain snares and nets for unwary birds and in effect a persistent invitation to the overturning of habitual evaluations and valued habits. What? Everything only- human, all too human? It is with this sigh that one emerges from my writings, not without a

kind of reserve and mistrust even in regard to morality, not a little tempted and emboldened, indeed, for once to play the advocate of the worst things: as though they have perhaps been only the worst slandered? My writings have been called a schooling in suspicion, even more in contempt, but fortunately also in courage, indeed in audacity. And in fact I myself do not believe that anyone has ever before looked into the world with an equally profound degree of suspicion, and not merely as an occasional devil's advocate, but, to speak theologically, just as much as an enemy and indicter of God; and anyone who could divine something of the consequences that lie in that profound suspiciousness, something of the fears and frosts of the isolation to which that unconditional disparity of view condemns him who is infected with it, will also understand how often, in an effort to recover from myself, as it were to induce a temporary self-forgetting, I have sought shelter in this or that - in some piece of admiration or enmity or scientificality or frivolity or stupidity; and why, where I could not find what I needed, I had artificially to enforce, falsify and invent a suitable fiction for myself (- and what else have poets ever done? and to what end does art exist in the world at all?). What I again and again needed most for my cure and self-restoration, however, was the belief that I was not thus isolated, not alone in seeing as I did - an enchanted surmising of relatedness and identity in eye and desires, a reposing in a trust of friendship, a blindness in concert with another without suspicion or question-marks, a pleasure in foregrounds, surfaces, things close and closest, in everything possessing colour, skin and apparitionality. Perhaps in this regard I might be reproached with having employed a certain amount of 'art', a certain amount of false-coinage: for • Birth of Tragedy: Nietzsche's first published book (1872) t Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future: the subtitle of Beyond Good and Evil, published in 1886 H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N example, that I knowingly-willfully closed my eyes before Schopenhauer's "blind will to morality at a time when I was already sufficiently clearsighted about morality; likewise that I deceived myself over Richard Wagner's incurable romanticism, as though it were a beginning and not an end; likewise over the Greeks, likewise over the Germans and their future - and perhaps a whole long list could be made of such likewises? Supposing, however, that all this were true and that I was reproached with it with good reason, what do you know, what could you know, of how much cunning in self-preservation, how much reason and higher safeguarding, is contained in such self-deception- or of how much falsity I shall require if I am to continue to permit myself the luxury of my truthfulness? . . . Enough, I am still living; and life is, after all, not a product of morality: it wants deception, it lives on deception . . . but there you are, I am already off again, am I not, and doing what I have always done, old immoralist and bird-catcher that I am - speaking unmorally, extramorally, 'beyond good and evil'? - Thus when I needed to I once also invented for myself

the 'free spirits' to whom this melancholy-valiant book with the title *Human, All Too Human* is dedicated: 'free spirits' of this kind do not exist, did not exist- but, as I have said, I had need of them at that time if I was to keep in good spirits while surrounded by ills (sickness, solitude, unfamiliar places, acedia, inactivity): as brave companions and familiars with whom one can laugh and chatter when one feels like laughing and chattering, and whom one can send to the Devil when they become tedious - as compensation for the friends I lacked. That free spirits of this kind could one day exist, that our Europe will have such active and audacious fellows among its sons of tomorrow and the next day, physically present and palpable and not, as in my case, merely phantoms and hermit's phantasmagoria: I should wish to be the last to doubt it . I see them already coming, slowly, slowly; and perhaps I shall do something to speed their coming if I describe in advance under what vicissitudes, upon what paths, I see them coming?-- One may conjecture that a spirit in whom the type 'free spirit' will one day become ripe and sweet to the point of perfection has had its decisive experience in a great liberation and that previously it was all the more a fettered spirit and seemed to be chained for ever to its pillar and corner. What fetters the fastest? What bonds are all but unbreakable? In the case of men of a high and select kind they will be their duties: that reverence proper to youth, that reserve and delicacy before all that is honoured and • Schopenhauer: Arthur Schopenhauer (1788-to), the philosopher, of whom Nietzsche was in his youth a disciple (see the essay, 'Schopenhauer as Educator' in the *Untimely Meditations*) t Richard Wagner (ttJ-8J), the composer and dramatist who was, like Schopenhauer, an object of the youthful Nietzsche's veneration (see the essay 'Richard Wagner in Bayreuth' in the *Untimely Meditations*)

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revered from of old, that gratitude for the soil out of which they have grown, for the hand which led them, for the holy place where they learned to worship- their supreme moments themselves will fetter them the fastest, lay upon them the most enduring obligation. The great liberation comes for those who are thus fettered suddenly, like the shock of an earthquake: the youthful soul is all at once convulsed, torn loose, torn away - it itself does not know what is happening. A drive and impulse rules and masters it like a command; a will and desire awakens to go off, anywhere, at any cost; a vehement dangerous curiosity for an undiscovered world flames and flickers in all its senses. 'Better to die than to go on living here' - thus responds the imperious voice and temptation: and this 'here', this 'at home' is everything it had hitherto loved! A sudden terror and suspicion of what it loved, a lightning-bolt of contempt for what it called 'duty', a rebellious, arbitrary, volcanically erupting desire for travel, strange places, estrangements, coldness, soberness, frost, a hatred of love, perhaps a desecrating blow and glance backwards to where it formerly loved and worshipped, perhaps a hot blush of shame at what it has just done and at the same time an exultation

that it has done it, a drunken, inwardly exultant shudder which betrays that a victory has been won - a victory? over what? over whom? an enigmatic, questionpacked, questionable victory, but the first victory nonetheless: such bad and painful things are part of the history of the great liberation. It is at the same time a sickness that can destroy the man who has it, this first outbreak of strength and will to self-determination, to evaluating on one's own account, this will to free will: and how much sickness is expressed in the wild experiments and singularities through which the liberated prisoner now seeks to demonstrate his mastery over things! He prowls cruelly around with an unslaked lasciviousness; what he captures has to expiate the perilous tension of his pride; what excites him he tears apart. With a wicked laugh he turns round whatever he finds veiled and through some sense of shame or other spared and pampered: he puts to the test what these things look like when they are reversed. It is an act of willfulness, and pleasure in willfulness, if now he perhaps bestows his favour on that which has hitherto had a bad reputation - if, full of inquisitiveness and the desire to tempt and experiment, he creeps around the things most forbidden. Behind all his toiling and weaving- for he is restlessly and aimlessly on his way as if in a desert- stands the questionmark of a more and more perilous curiosity. 'Can all values not be turned round? and is good perhaps evil? and God only an invention and finesse of the Devil? Is everything perhaps in the last resort false? And if we are deceived, are we not for that very reason also deceivers? must we not be deceivers?' - such thoughts as these tempt him and lead him on, even further away, even further down. Solitude encircles and embraces him, ever more threatening, suffocating, heart-tightening, that terrible goddess and mater saeva cupidinum .. - but who today knows what solitude is? . . . • mater saeva cupidinum: wild mother of the passions H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N

From this morbid isolation, from the desert of these years of temptation and experiment, it is still a long road to that tremendous overflowing certainty and health which may not dispense even with wickedness, as a means and fish-hook of knowledge, to that mature freedom of spirit which is equally self-mastery and discipline of the heart and permits access to many and contradictory modes of thought- to that inner spaciousness and indulgence of superabundance which excludes the danger that the spirit may even on its own road perhaps lose itself and become infatuated and remain seated intoxicated in some corner or other, to that superfluity of formative, curative, moulding and restorative forces which is precisely the sign of great health, that superfluity which grants to the free spirit the dangerous privilege of living experimentally and of being allowed to offer itself to adventure: the master's privilege of the free spirit! In between there may lie long years of convalescence, years full of variegated, painfully magical transformations ruled and led along by a tenacious will to health which often ventures to clothe and disguise itself as health already achieved. There is a

midway condition which a man of such a destiny will not be able to recall without emotion: it is characterized by a pale, subtle happiness of light and sunshine, a feeling of birdlike freedom, bird-like altitude, bird-like exuberance, and a third thing in which curiosity is united with a tender contempt. A 'free-spirit'- this cool expression does one good in every condition, it is almost warming. One lives no longer in the fetters of love and hatred, without yes, without no, near or far as one wishes, preferably slipping away, evading, fluttering off, gone again, again flying aloft; one is spoiled, as everyone is who has at some time seen a tremendous number of things beneath him- and one becomes the opposite of those who concern themselves with things which have nothing to do with them. Indeed, the free spirit henceforth has to do only with things - and how many things! - with which he is no longer concerned . . . A step further in convalescence: and the free spirit again draws near to life- slowly, to be sure, almost reluctantly, almost mistrustfully. It again grows warmer around him, yellower, as it were; feeling and feeling for others acquire depth, warm breezes of all kind blow across him. It seems to him as if his eyes are only now open to what is close at hand. He is astonished and sits silent: where had he been? These close and closest things: how changed they seem! what bloom and magic they have acquired! He looks back gratefully- grateful to his wandering, to his hardness and selfalienation, to his viewing of far distances and bird-like flights in cold heights. What a good thing he had not always stayed 'at home', stayed 'under his own roof like a delicate apathetic loafer! He had been beside himself: no doubt of that. Only now does he see himself- and what surprises he experiences as he does so! What unprecedented shudders! PREFACE What happiness even in the weariness, the old sickness, the relapses of the convalescent! How he loves to sit sadly still, to spin out patience, to lie in the sun! Who understands as he does the happiness that comes in winter, the spots of sunlight on the wall! They are the most grateful animals in the world, also the most modest, these convalescents and lizards again half turned towards life: - there are some among them who allow no day to pass without hanging a little song of praise on the hem of its departing robe. And, to speak seriously: to become sick in the manner of these free spirits, to remain sick for a long time and then, slowly, slowly, to become healthy, by which I mean 'healthier', is a fundamental cure for all pessimism (the cancerous sore and inveterate vice, as is well known, of old idealists and inveterate liars) . There is wisdom, practical wisdom, in for a long time prescribing even health for oneself only in small doses. - At that time it may finally happen that, under the sudden illumination of a still stressful, still changeable health, the free, ever freer spirit begins to unveil the riddle of that great liberation which had until then waited dark, questionable, almost untouchable in his memory. If he has for long hardly dared to ask himself: 'why so apart? so alone? renouncing everything I once revered? renouncing

reverence itself? why this hardness, this suspiciousness, this hatred for your own virtues?' - now he dares to ask it aloud and hears in reply something like an answer. 'You shall become master over yourself, master also over your virtues. Formerly they were your masters; but they must be only your instruments beside other instruments. You shall get control over your For and Against and learn how to display first one and then the other in accordance with your higher goal. You shall learn to grasp the sense of perspective in every value judgement - the displacement, distortion and merely apparent teleology of horizons and whatever else pertains to perspectivism; also the quantum of stupidity that resides in antitheses of values and the whole intellectual loss which every For, every Against costs us. You shall learn to grasp the necessary injustice in every For and Against, injustice as inseparable from life, life itself as conditioned by the sense of perspective and its injustice. You shall above all see with your own eyes where injustice is always at its greatest: where life has developed at its smallest, narrowest, neediest, most incipient and yet cannot avoid taking itself as the goal and measure of things and for the sake of its own preservation secretly and meanly and ceaselessly crumbling away and calling into question the higher, greater, richer - you shall see with your own eyes the problem of order of rank, and how power and right and spaciousness of perspective grow into the heights together. You shall' - enough: from now on the free spirit knows what 'you shall' he has obeyed, and he also knows what he now can, what only now he - may do . . . H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N This is how the free spirit elucidates to himself that enigma of liberation, and inasmuch as he generalizes his own case ends by adjudicating on what he has experienced thus. 'What has happened to me', he says to himself, 'must happen to everyone in whom a task wants to become incarnate and "come into the world".' The secret force and necessity of this task will rule among and in the individual facets of his destiny like an unconscious pregnancy - long before he has caught sight of this task itself or knows its name. Our vocation commands and disposes of us even when we do not yet know it; it is the future that regulates our today. Given it is the problem of order of rank of which we may say it is our problem, we free spirits: it is only now, at the midday of our life, that we understand what preparations, bypaths, experiments, temptations, disguises the problem had need of before it was allowed to rise up before us, and how we first had to experience the most manifold and contradictory states of joy and distress in soul and body, as adventurers and circumnavigators of that inner world called 'man', as surveyors and guagers of that 'higher' and 'one upon the other' that is likewise called 'man'- penetrating everywhere, almost without fear, disdaining nothing, losing nothing, asking everything, cleansing everything of what is chance and accident in it and as it were thoroughly sifting it- until at last we had the right to say, we free spirits: 'Here - a new problem! Here a long ladder upon whose rungs we

ourselves have sat and climbed - which we ourselves have at some time been!
 Here a higher, a deeper, a beneath-us, a tremendous long ordering, an order of
 rank, which we see: here - our problem!' -- - No psychologist or reader of signs
 will have a moment's difficulty in recognizing to what stage in the evolution just
 described the present book belongs (or has been placed -). But where today are
 there psychologists? In France, certainly; perhaps in Russia; definitely not in
 Germany. There is no lack of reasons as to why the Germans of today could even
 regard this fact as redounding to their honour: an ill fate for one who in this
 matter is by nature and attainment un-German! This German book, which has
 known how to find its readers in a wide circle of lands and peoples- it has been
 on its way for about ten years- and must be capable of some kind of music and
 flute-player's art by which even coy foreign ears are seduced to listen - it is
 precisely in Germany that this book has been read most carelessly and heard the
 worst: why is that?- 'It demands too much', has been the reply, 'it addresses itself
 to people who are not oppressed by uncouth duties, it wants refined and
 experienced senses, it needs superfluity, superfluity of time, of clarity in heart
 and sky, of otium• in the most audacious sense: - all of them good things that we
 Ger- • otium: leisure, idleness; in Catullus' usage, it denotes a vice or condition
 of ennui. PREFACE mans of today do not have and therefore also cannot give'. -
 After so courteous a reply my philosophy advises me to keep silent and to ask no
 more questions; especially as in certain cases, as the saying has it, one remains a
 philosopher only by- keeping silent. Nice Spring 1 886 1 1 OF FIRST AND
 LAST THINGS Chemistry of concepts and sensations. - Almost all the problems
 of philosophy once again pose the same form of question as they did two
 thousand years ago: how can something originate in its opposite, for example
 rationality in irrationality, the sentient in the dead, logic in unlogic, disinterested
 contemplation in covetous desire, living for others in egoism, truth in error?
 Metaphysical philosophy has hitherto surmounted this difficulty by denying that
 the one originates in the other and assuming for the more highly valued thing a
 miraculous source in the very kernel and being of the 'thing in itself'.* Historical
 philosophy, on the other hand, which can no longer be separated from natural
 science, the youngest of all philosophical methods, has discovered in individual
 cases (and this will probably be the result in every case) that there are no
 opposites, except in the customary exaggeration of popular or metaphysical
 interpretations, and that a mistake in reasoning lies at the bottom of this
 antithesis: according to this explanation there exists, strictly speaking, neither an
 unegoistic action nor completely disinterested contemplation; both are only
 sublimations, in which the basic element seems almost to have dispersed and
 reveals itself only under the most painstaking observation. All we require, and
 what can be given us only now the individual sciences have attained their present
 level, is a chemistry of the moral, religious and aesthetic conceptions and

sensations, likewise of all the agitations we experience within ourselves in cultural and social intercourse, and indeed even when we are alone: what if this chemistry would end up by revealing that in this domain too the most glorious colours are derived from base, indeed from despised materials? Will there be many who desire to pursue such researches? Mankind likes to put questions of origins and beginnings out of its mind: must one not be almost inhuman to detect in oneself a contrary inclination? - Family failing of philosophers. - All philosophers have the common failing of starting out from man as he is now and thinking they can reach their goal through an analysis of him. They involuntarily think of 'man' as an aeterna veritas, t as something that remains constant in the midst of all flux, as a sure measure of things. Everything the philosopher has • thing-in-itself: Kant's term for objects as they are independently of our knowledge of them, contrasted (see section 10) with 'appearances', objects considered as conforming to our modes of knowing them t aeterna veritas: something everlastingly true OF FIRST A N D LAST THINGS declared about man is, however, at bottom no more than a testimony as to the man of a very limited period of time. Lack of historical sense is the family failing of all philosophers; many, without being aware of it, even take the most recent manifestation of man, such as has arisen under the impress of certain religions, even certain political events, as the fixed form from which one has to start out. They will not learn that man has become, that the faculty of cognition has become; while some of them would have it that the whole world is spun out of this faculty of cognition. Now, everything essential in the development of mankind took place in primeval times, long before the four thousand years we more or less know about; during these years mankind may well not have altered very much. But the philosopher here sees 'instincts' in man as he now is and assumes that these belong to the unalterable facts of mankind and to that extent could provide a key to the understanding of the world in general: the whole of teleology is constructed by speaking of the man of the last four millennia as of an eternal man towards whom all things in the world have had a natural relationship from the time he began. But everything has become: there are no eternal facts, just as there are no absolute truths. Consequently what is needed from now on is historical philosophizing, and with it the virtue of modesty. Estimation of unpretentious truths. - It is the mark of a higher culture to value the little unpretentious truths which have been discovered by means of rigorous method more highly than the errors handed down by metaphysical and artistic ages and men, which blind us and make us happy. At first the former are regarded with scorn, as though the two things could not possibly be accorded equal rights: they stand there so modest, simple, sober, so apparently discouraging, while the latter are so fair, splendid, intoxicating, perhaps indeed enrapturing. Yet that which has been attained by laborious struggle, the certain, enduring and thus of significance

for any further development of knowledge is nonetheless the higher; to adhere to it is manly and demonstrates courage, simplicity and abstemiousness. Gradually not only the individual but all mankind will be raised to this manliness, when they have finally become accustomed to valuing viable, enduring knowledge more highly and lost all faith in inspiration and the acquisition of knowledge by miraculous means. - Worshipers of form, with their standards of the beautiful and sublime, will, to be sure, at first have good ground for mockery once estimation of unpretentious truths and the scientific spirit begins to dominate: but only because either their eye has not yet discovered the charm of the simplest form or because those raised in that spirit are as yet very far from being thoroughly permeated by it, so that they still thoughtlessly imitate old forms (and do so badly, as does everyone to whom a thing no longer matters very much). Formerly the spirit was not engaged in rigorous thinking, its serious occupation was the spinning out of forms and symbols. That has now changed; serious occupation with the symbolic I S H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N has become a mark of a lower culture. As our arts themselves grow ever more intellectual, our senses more spiritual, and as for example we now adjudge what is pleasant sounding quite differently from the way we did a hundred years ago: so the forms of our life will grow ever more spiritual, perhaps to the eye of earlier ages uglier, but only because it is incapable of seeing how the realm of inner, spiritual beauty is continually growing deeper and wider, and to what extent we may all now accord the eye of insight greater value than the fairest structure or the sublimest edifice. Astrology and what is related to it. - It is probable that the objects of the religious, moral and aesthetic sensations belong only to the surface of things, while man likes to believe that here at least he is in touch with the world's heart; the reason he deludes himself is that these things produce in him such profound happiness and unhappiness, and thus he exhibits here the same pride as in the case of astrology. For astrology believes the starry firmament revolves around the fate of man; the moral man, however, supposes that what he has essentially at heart must also constitute the essence and heart of things. Misunderstanding of the dream. - The man of the ages of barbarous primordial culture believed that in the dream he was getting to know a second real world: here is the origin of all metaphysics. Without the dream one would have had no occasion to divide the world into two. The dissection into soul and body is also connected with the oldest idea of the dream, likewise the postulation of a life of the soul,* thus the origin of all belief in spirits, and probably also of the belief in gods. 'The dead live on, for they appear to the living in dreams': that was the conclusion one formerly drew, throughout many millennia. The spirit of science rules its parts, not the whole. - The separate smallest regions of science are treated purely objectively: the great universal sciences, on the other hand, viewed as a whole pose the question- a very unobjective question, to be sure - to

what end? of what utility? On account of this regard for utility they are as a whole treated less impersonally than they are in their parts. And when it comes to philosophy, the summit of the entire scientific pyramid, we find the question as to the utility of knowledge as such involuntarily raised, and the unconscious intention of every philosophy is to ascribe to it the highest utility. That is why there is in all philosophies so much high-flying metaphysics and such a dread of the explanations offered by physics, which seem so modest and insignificant; for the significance of knowledge for life has to appear as great as it possibly can. Here lies the antagonism between the individual regions of science and philosophy. The latter wants, as art does, to bestow on life and action the greatest possible profundity and signifi- • life of the soul: Seelenscheinleib, Nietzsche's coinage OF FIRST AND LAST THINGS; in the former one seeks knowledge and nothing further - and does in fact acquire it. There has hitherto been no philosopher in whose hands philosophy has not become an apologia for knowledge; on this point at least each of them is an optimist, inasmuch as he believes that knowledge must be in the highest degree useful. They are all tyrannized over by logic: and logic is by its nature optimism. The mischief-maker in science. - Philosophy separated itself from science when it posed the question: what kind of knowledge of the world and life is it through which man can live happiest? This took place in the Socratic schools: by having in view the objective of happiness one applied a ligature to the arteries of scientific research - and does so still today. Pneumatological elucidation of nature. - Metaphysics elucidates the handwriting of nature as it were pneumatologically, • as the church and its scholars formerly did the Bible. It requires a great deal of understanding to apply to nature the same kind of rigorous art of elucidation that philologists have now fashioned for all books: with the intention of comprehending what the text intends to say but without sensing, indeed presupposing, a second meaning. But as even with regard to books the bad art of elucidation has by no means been entirely overcome and one still continually encounters in the best educated circles remnants of allegorical and mystical interpretations: so it is also in respect to nature - where, indeed, it is even far worse. Metaphysical world. - It is true, there could be a metaphysical world; the absolute possibility of it is hardly to be disputed. We behold all things through the human head and cannot cut off this head; while the question nonetheless remains what of the world would still be there if one had cut it off. This is a purely scientific problem and one not very well calculated to bother people overmuch; but all that has hitherto made metaphysical assumptions valuable, terrible, delightful to them, all that has begotten these assumptions, is passion, error and self-deception; the worst of all methods of acquiring knowledge, not the best of all, have taught belief in them. When one has disclosed these methods as the foundation of all extant religions and metaphysical systems, one has refuted them! Then that possibility still

remains over; but one can do absolutely nothing with it, not to speak of letting happiness, salvation and life depend on the gossamer of such a possibility. - For one could assert nothing at all of the metaphysical world except that it was a being-other, an inaccessible, incomprehensible being-other; it would be a thing with negative qualities. - Even if the existence of such a world were never so well demonstrated, it is certain that knowledge of it would be the most useless of all • pneumatologically: pneumatology is the 'science' of spirits and spiritual beings H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N knowledge: more useless even than knowledge of the chemical composition of water must be to the sailor in danger of shipwreck. Future innocuousness of metaphysics. - As soon as the origin of religion, art and morality is so described that it can be perfectly understood without the postulation of metaphysical interference at the commencement or in the course of their progress, the greater part of our interest in the purely theoretical problem of the 'thing in itself' and 'appearance' ceases to exist. For with religion, art and morality we do not touch upon the 'nature of the world in itself'; we are in the realm of ideas, no 'intuition' can take us any further. The question of how our conception of the world could differ so widely from the disclosed nature of the world will with perfect equanimity be relinquished to the physiology and history of the evolution of organisms and concepts. Language as putative science. - The significance of language for the evolution of culture lies in this, that mankind set up in language a separate world beside the other world, a place it took to be so firmly set that, standing upon it, it could lift the rest of the world off its hinges and make itself master of it. To the extent that man has for long ages believed in the concepts and names of things as in aeternae veritates he has appropriated to himself that pride by which he raised himself above the animal: he really thought that in language he possessed knowledge of the world. The sculptor of language was not so modest as to believe that he was only giving things designations, he conceived rather that with words he was expressing supreme knowledge of things; language is, in fact, the first stage of the occupation with science. Here, too, it is the belief that the truth has been found out of which the mightiest sources of energy have flowed. A great deal later - only now - it dawns on men that in their belief in language they have propagated a tremendous error.* Happily, it is too late for the evolution of reason, which depends on this belief, to be again put back. Logic - too depends on presuppositions with which nothing in the real world corresponds, for example on the presupposition that there are identical things, that the same thing is identical at different points of time: but this science came into existence through the opposite belief (that such conditions do obtain in the real world). It is the same with mathematics, which would certainly not have come into existence if one had known from the beginning that there was in nature no exactly straight line, no real circle, no absolute magnitude. 1 2 Dream and culture. - The function

of the brain that sleep encroaches upon most is the memory: not that it ceases altogether - but it is reduced to a condition of imperfection such as in the primeval ages of mankind may have been normal by day and in waking. Confused and capricious as it is, • Nietzsche had described this error in detail in Truth and Falsehood in the Extra-Mora/ Sense (1873)• OF F I R S T A N D L A S T T H I N G S it continually confuses one thing with another on the basis of the most fleeting similarities: but it was with the same confusion and capriciousness that the peoples composed their mythologies, and even today travellers observe how much the savage is inclined to forgetfulness, how his mind begins to reel and stumble after a brief exertion of the memory and he utters lies and nonsense out of mere enervation. But in dreams we all resemble this savage; failure to recognize correctly and erroneously supposing one thing to be the same as another is the ground of the false conclusions of which we are guilty in dreams; so that, when we clearly recall a dream, we are appalled to discover so much folly in ourselves. - The perfect clarity of all the images we see in dreams which is the precondition of our unquestioning belief in their reality again reminds us of conditions pertaining to earlier mankind, in whom hallucination was extraordinarily common and sometimes seized hold on whole communities, whole peoples at the same time. Thus: in sleep and dreams we repeat once again the curriculum of earlier mankind.* Logic of the dream. - In sleep our nervous system is continually agitated by a multiplicity of inner events, almost all our organs are active, our blood circulates vigorously, the position of the sleeper presses on individual limbs, his bedcovers influence his sensibilities in various ways, his stomach digests and its motions disturb other organs, his intestines are active, the position of his head involves unusual muscular contortions, his feet, unshod and not pressing against the floor, produce an unfamiliar feeling, as does the difference in the way his whole body is clad - all this, through its unusualness and to a differing degree each day, excites the entire system up to the functioning of the brain; and so there are a hundred occasions for the mind to be involved in puzzlement and to look for grounds for this excitation: the dream is the seeking and positing of the causes of this excitement of the sensibilities, that is to say the supposed causes. If, for example, you tie two straps about your feet you may well dream that your feet are coiled round by snakes: this is first a hypothesis, then a belief, with an accompanying pictorial representation and the supposition: 'these snakes must be the causa of those sensations that I, the sleeper, feel' - thus the sleeper's mind judges. The immediate past he has thus inferred becomes through his aroused imagination the present to him. Everyone knows from experience how quickly a dreamer entwines with his dream a sound that strongly impinges upon him from without, the ringing of bells or the firing of cannon, for example; that is to say, he accounts for the sound in terms of the dream, so that he believes he experiences the cause of the sound first, then the sound itself. - But how does

it come about that the dreamer's mind always blunders like this, • In The Interpretation of Dreams, ch. VII (B), Freud writes: 'We can guess how much to the point is Nietzsche's assertion that in dreams "some primeval relic of humanity is at work which we can now scarcely reach any longer by a direct path"; and we may expect that the analysis of dreams will lead us to a knowledge of man's archaic heritage, of what is psychologically innate in him.' H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N when the same mind is accustomed to be so sober, cautious and so sceptical with regard to hypotheses while it is awake? - so that the first plausible hypothesis for explaining a sensation that occurs to him is at once accepted as the truth? (For in dreams we believe in the dream as though it were reality, that is to say we regard our hypothesis as completely proved.) - In my opinion, the conclusions man still draws in dreams to the present day for many millennia mankind also drew when awake: the first causa that entered the mind as an explanation of anything that required explaining satisfied it and was accounted truth. (According to travellers' tales savages still do this today.) In the dream this piece of primeval humanity continues to exercise itself, for it is the basis upon which higher rationality evolved and continues to evolve in every human being: the dream takes us back again to remote stages of human culture and provides us with a means of understanding them better. We now find dream-thinking* so easy because it is in precisely this imaginative and agreeable form of explanation by means of the first plausible idea that strikes us that we have been so well drilled over such enormous periods of human evolution. To this extent the dream is a relaxation for the brain, which has had enough of the strenuous demands in the way of thinking such as are imposed by our higher culture during the day. - A related occurrence which stands as portal and entrance-hall of the dream can actually be observed in full wakefulness. If we close our eyes, the brain produces a host of light-impressions and colours, probably as a kind of after-play and echo of those effects of light which crowd in upon it during the day. Now, however, the reason (in alliance with the imagination) at once assembles these in themselves formless colour-impressions into definite figures, shapes, landscapes, moving groups. What is actually occurring is again a kind of inferring of the cause from the effect; the mind asks where these light-impressions and colours come from and supposes these shapes and figures are their causes: it regards them as occasioning these lights and colours because, by day and with eyes open, it is accustomed to finding that every colour, every light-impression does in fact have a cause that occasions it. Here, then, the imagination is continually providing the mind with images borrowed from the sight-impressions of the day, and this is precisely the way in which it fashions the dreamfantasy: - that is to say, the supposed cause is inferred from the effect and introduced after the effect: and all with extraordinary rapidity, so that, as with a conjurer, a confusion of judgement can here arise and

successive events appear as simultaneous events or even with the order of their occurrence reversed. - These facts show us how late more rigorous logical thinking, a clear perception of the nature of cause and effect, must have been evolved if our faculties of reason and understanding even now involuntarily grasp at those primitive forms of conclusion and inference and we still live about half of our life in this condition. - The poet and the artist, too, foists upon his moods and states of mind causes which are certainly not the true ones; to this extent he recalls an earlier humanity and can aid us to an understanding of it. Sympathetic resonance. - All stronger moods bring with them a sympathetic resonance on the part of related sensations and moods: they as it were root up the memory. Something in us is provoked to recollection and becomes aware of similar states and their origins. Thus there come to be constructed habitual rapid connections between feelings and thoughts which, if they succeed one another with lightning speed, are in the end no longer experienced as complexes but as unities. It is in this sense that one speaks of the moral feelings, of the religious feelings, as though these were simple unities: in truth, however, they are rivers with a hundred tributaries and sources. Here too, as so often, the unity of the word is no guarantee of the unity of the thing. No inner and outer in the world. - As Democritus transferred the concepts Above and Below to infinite space, where they make no sense, so philosophers in general transfer the concept 'inner and outer' to the essence and phenomena of the world; they believe that profound feelings take one deep into the interior, close to the heart of nature. But such feelings are profound only insofar as when they occur certain complex groups of thoughts which we call profound are, scarcely perceptibly, regularly aroused with them; a feeling is profound because we regard the thoughts that accompany it as profound. But a profound thought can nonetheless be very distant from the truth, as, for example, every metaphysical thought is; if one deducts from the profound feeling the element of thought mixed in with it, what remains is the strong feeling, and this has nothing to do with knowledge as such, just as strong belief demonstrates only its strength, not the truth of that which is believed. Appearance and thing in itself. - Philosophers are accustomed to station themselves before life and experience - before that which they call the world of appearance - as before a painting that has been unrolled once and for all and unchangeably depicts the same scene: this scene, they believe, has to be correctly interpreted, so as to draw a conclusion as to the nature of the being that produced the picture: that is to say, as to the nature of the thing in itself, which it is customary to regard as the sufficient reason for the existence of the world of appearance. As against this, more rigorous logicians, having clearly identified the concept of the metaphysical as that of the unconditioned, consequently also unconditioning, have disputed any connection between the unconditioned (the

metaphysical world) and the world we know: so that what appears in •

Democritus (c. 460 to c. 370 BC): Greek philosopher, one of the latest of the so-called 'pre Socratic' philosophers t The principle of sufficient reason's various formulations include 'every existent has a ground' and 'every event has a cause'; Schopenhauer discussed the history and justification of the prindple in The Fourfold Root of the Principle of Sufficient Reason (1813). H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N appearance is precisely not the thing in itself, and no conclusion can be drawn from the former as to the nature of the latter. Both parties, however, overlook the possibility that this painting - that which we humans call life and experience - has gradually become, is indeed still fully in course of becoming, and should thus not be regarded as a fixed object on the basis of which a conclusion as to the nature of its originator (the sufficient reason) may either be drawn or pronounced undrawable. Because we have for millennia made moral, aesthetic, religious demands on the world, looked upon it with blind desire, passion or fear, and abandoned ourselves to the bad habits of illogical thinking, this world has gradually become so marvellously variegated, frightful, meaningful, soulful, it has acquired colour - but we have been the colourists: it is the human intellect that has made appearance appear and transported its erroneous basic conceptions into things. Late, very late - it has reflected on all this: and now the world of experience and the thing in itself seem to it so extraordi· narily different from one another and divided apart that it rejects the idea that the nature of one can be inferred from the nature of the other - or invites us in a chillingly mysterious fashion to abandon our intellect, our personal will: so as to attain to the real by becoming real oneself. Others again have assembled all the characteristic traits of our world of appearance - that is to say, the idea of the world spun out of intellectual errors we have inherited - and, instead of indicting the intellect as the guilty party, have charged the essence of things with being the cause of the very uncanny character this world in fact possesses and have preached redemption from being. - With all these conceptions the steady and laborious process of science, which will one day celebrate its greatest triumph in a history of the genesis of thought, will in the end decisively have done; for the outcome of this history may well be the conclusion: That which we now call the world is the outcome of a host of errors and fantasies which have gradually arisen and grown entwined with one another in the course of the overall evolution of the organic being, and are now inherited by us as the accumulated treasure of the entire past - as treasure: for the value of our humanity depends upon it. Rigorous science is capable of detaching us from this ideational world only to a limited extent - and more is certainly not to be desired - inasmuch as it is incapable of making any essential inroad into the power of habits of feeling acquired in primeval times: but it can, quite gradually and step by step, illuminate the history of the genesis of this world as idea - and, for brief

periods at any rate, lift us up out of the entire proceeding. Perhaps we shall then recognize that the thing in itself is worthy of Homeric laughter: that it appeared to be so much, indeed everything, and is actually empty, that is to say empty of significance. Metaphysical explanations. - The young person values metaphysical explanations because they reveal to him something in the highest degree significant in things he found unpleasant or contemptible; and if he is 20 O F F I R S T A N D L A S T T H I N G S discontented with himself this feeling is alleviated when he comes to recognize the innermost enigma or misery of the universe in that which he so much condemns in himself. To feel more irresponsible and at the same time to find things more interesting - that is the twofold benefit for which he believes he has metaphysics to thank. Later on, to be sure, he acquires mistrust of the whole metaphysical mode of explanation; then perhaps he sees that the effects he has experienced are to be attained equally well and more scientifically by another route: that physical and historical explanations produce that feeling of irresponsibility at least as well, and that interest in life and its problems is perhaps enflamed even more by them. Fundamental questions of metaphysics. When one day the history of the - genesis of thought comes to be written, the following sentence by a distinguished logician will also stand revealed in a new light: 'The primary universal law of the knowing subject consists in the inner necessity of recognizing every object in itself as being in its own essence something identical with itself, thus self-existent and at bottom always the same and unchanging, in short as a substance'. This law, too, which is here called 'primary', evolved: one day it will be shown how gradually, in the lower organisms, this tendency comes into being: how the purblind mole's eyes of this organization at first never see anything but the same thing; how then, when the various pleasurable and unpleasurable stimuli become more noticeable, various different substances are gradually distinguished, but each of them with one attribute, that is to say a single relationship with such an organism. - The first stage of the logical is the judgement: and the essence of the judgement consists, according to the best logicians, in belief. At the bottom of all belief there lies the sensation of the pleasurable or painful in respect to the subject experiencing the sensation. A new, third sensation as a product of two preceding single sensations is the judgement in its lowest form. -- In our primary condition, all that interests us organic beings in any thing is its relationship to us in respect of pleasure and pain. Between the moments in which we become conscious of this relationship, the states of awareness of sensation, lie those of repose, of non-sensation: then the world and every thing is devoid of interest to us, we notice no alteration in it (just as now anyone absorbed with interest in something will still not notice someone walking by him). To the plants all things are usually in repose, eternal, every thing identical with itself. It is from the period of the lower organisms that man has inherited the belief that there are

identical things (only knowledge educated in the highest scientificity contradicts this proposition). It may even be that the original belief of everything organic was from the very beginning that all the rest of the world is one and unmoving. - What lies farthest from this primeval stage of the logical is the notion of causality: even now, indeed, we believe at bottom that all sensations and actions are acts of free will; when the sentient individuum 21 H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N observes itself, it regards every sensation, every change, as something isolated, that is to say unconditioned, disconnected: it emerges out of us independently of anything earlier or later. We are hungry, but originally we do not think that the organism wants to sustain itself; this feeling seems to be asserting itself without cause or purpose, it isolates itself and considers itself willful. Thus: belief in freedom of will is a primary error committed by everything organic, as old as the impulse to the logical itself; belief in unconditioned substances and in identical things is likewise a primary, ancient error committed by everything organic. Insofar, however, as all metaphysics has had principally to do with substance and freedom of will, one may designate it the science that treats of the fundamental errors of mankind - but does so as though they were fundamental truths. Number. - The invention of the laws of numbers was made on the basis of the error, dominant even from the earliest times, that there are identical things (but in fact nothing is identical with anything else); at least that there are things (but there is no 'thing'). The assumption of plurality always presupposes the existence of something that occurs more than once: but precisely here error already holds sway, here already we are fabricating beings, unities which do not exist. - Our sensations of space and time are false, for tested consistently they lead to logical contradictions. The establishment of conclusions in science always unavoidably involves us in calculating with certain false magnitudes: but because these magnitudes are at least constant, as for example are our sensations of time and space, the conclusions of science acquire a complete rigorousness and certainty in their coherence with one another; one can build on them - up to that final stage at which our erroneous basic assumptions, those constant errors, come to be incompatible with our conclusions, for example in the theory of atoms. Here we continue to feel ourselves compelled to assume the existence of a 'thing' or material 'substratum' which is moved, while the whole procedure of science has pursued the task of resolving everything thing-like (material) in motions: here too our sensations divide that which moves from that which is moved, and we cannot get out of this circle because our belief in the existence of things has been tied up with our being from time immemorial. - When Kant says 'the understanding does not draw its laws from nature, it prescribes them to nature', this is wholly true with regard to the concept of nature which we are obliged to attach to nature (nature world as idea, that is as error), = but which is the summation of a host of errors of the

understanding. - To a world which is not our idea the laws of numbers are wholly inapplicable: these are valid only in the human world. A few steps back. - One, certainly very high level of culture has been attained when a man emerges from superstitious and religious concepts and fears and no longer believes in angels, for example, or in original sin, OF F I R S T A N D L A S T T H I N G S and has ceased to speak of the salvation of souls: if he is at this level of liberation he now has, with the greatest exertion of mind, to overcome metaphysics. Then, however, he needs to take a retrograde step: he has to grasp the historical justification that resides in such ideas, likewise the psychological; he has to recognize that they have been most responsible for the advancement of mankind and that without such a retrograde step he will deprive himself of the best that mankind has hitherto produced. - In regard to philosophical metaphysics, I see more and more who are making for the negative goal (that all positive metaphysics is an error), but still few who are taking a few steps back; for one may well want to look out over the topmost rung of the ladder, but one ought not to want to stand on it. The most enlightened get only as far as liberating themselves from metaphysics and looking back on it from above: whereas here too, as in the hippodrome, at the end of the track it is necessary to turn the corner. Probable victory of scepticism. Let us for once accept the validity of the - sceptical point of departure: if there were no other, metaphysical world and all explanations of the only world known to us drawn from metaphysics were useless to us, in what light would we then regard men and things? This question can be thought through, and it is valuable to do so, even if we do for once ignore the question whether the existence of anything metaphysical has been scientifically demonstrated by Kant and Schopenhauer. For the historical probability is that one day mankind will very possibly become in general and on the whole sceptical in this matter; thus the question becomes: what shape will human society then assume under the influence of such an attitude of mind? Perhaps the scientific demonstration of the existence of any kind of metaphysical world is already so difficult that mankind will never again be free of a mistrust of it. And if one has a mistrust of metaphysics the results are by and large the same as if it had been directly refuted and one no longer had the right to believe in it. The historical question in regard to an unmetaphysical attitude of mind on the part of mankind remains the same in both cases. Disbelief in the 'monumentum aere perennius'. * - An essential disadvantage which the cessation of the metaphysical outlook brings with it lies in the fact that the attention of the individual is too firmly fixed on his own brief span of life and receives no stronger impulse to work at the construction of enduring institutions intended to last for centuries; he wants to pluck the fruit himself from the tree he plants, and he is therefore no longer interested in planting those trees which demand constant tending for a century and are intended to provide shade for long

successions of generations. For the metaphysical outlook bestows the belief that it offers the last, ultimate foundation upon which the whole future of mankind is then invited to establish and construct itself; the individual is promoting 'monumentum aere perennius': a memorial longer lasting than bronze (Horace) HUMAN, ALL TOOHUMAN his salvation when, for example, he founds a church or a convent, he thinks it will be accounted to his credit and rewarded in the eternal future life of his soul, it is a contribution to the eternal salvation of the soul. - Can science, too, awaken such faith in its conclusions? The fact is that science needs doubt and distrust for its closest allies; nonetheless, the sum of unimpeachable truths - truths, that is, which have survived all the assaults of scepticism and disintegration - can in time become so great (in the dietetics of health, for example) that on the basis of them one may resolve to embark on 'everlasting' works. In the meanwhile, the contrast between our agitated ephemeral existence and the slow-breathing repose of metaphysical ages is still too strong, because the two ages are still too close together; the individual human being himself now runs through far too many inner and outer evolutions for him to venture to establish himself securely and once and for all even for so short a span as his own lifetime. A completely modern man who wants, for example, to build himself a house has at the same time the feeling he is proposing to immure himself alive in a mausoleum. Age of comparison. - The less men are bound by tradition, the greater is the fermentation of motivations within them, and the greater in consequence their outward restlessness, their mingling together with one another, the polyphony of their endeavours. Who is there who now still feels a strong compulsion to attach himself and his posterity to a particular place? Who is there who still feels any strong attachment at all? Just as in the arts all the genres are imitated side by side, so are all the stages and genres of morality, custom, culture. - Such an age acquires its significance through the fact that in it the various different philosophies of life, customs, cultures can be compared and experienced side by side; which in earlier ages, when, just as all artistic genres were attached to a particular place and time, so every culture still enjoyed only a localized domination, was not possible. Now an enhanced aesthetic sensibility will come to a definitive decision between all these forms offering themselves for comparison: most of them - namely all those rejected by this sensibility - it will allow to die out. There is likewise now taking place a selecting out among the forms and customs of higher morality whose objective can only be the elimination of the lower moralities. This is the age of comparison! It is the source of its pride - but, as is only reasonable, also of its suffering. Let us not be afraid of this suffering! Let us rather confront the task which the age sets us as boldly as we can: and then posterity will bless us for it - a posterity that will know itself to be as much beyond the self-enclosed original national cultures as it is beyond the culture of comparison, but will look back upon both species of culture as upon

venerable antiquities. Possibility of progress. - When a scholar of the old culture swears to have nothing more to do with people who believe in progress he is right. For the old culture has its goods and greatness behind it and history compels OF FIRST AND LAST THINGS one to admit that it can never be fresh again; one needs to be intolerably stupid or fanatical to deny this. But men are capable of consciously resolving to evolve themselves to a new culture, whereas formerly they did so unconsciously and fortuitously: they can now create better conditions for the propagation of men and for their nutrition, education and instruction, manage the earth as a whole economically, balance and employ the powers of men in general. This new, conscious culture destroys the old, which viewed as a whole has led an unconscious animal- and plant-life; it also destroys mistrust of progress - it is possible. It would, of course, be rash and almost nonsensical to believe that progress must necessarily follow; but how could it be denied that progress is possible? On the other hand, progress in the sense and along the paths of the old culture is not even thinkable. If romantic fantasizings still do designate their goals (e.g. self-contained original national cultures) as 'progress', they nonetheless borrow their image of it from the past: in this domain their thinking and imagining lacks all originality. Private and public morality. - Since the belief has ceased that a God broadly directs the destinies of the world and that, all the apparent twists and turns in its path notwithstanding, is leading mankind gloriously upward, man has to set himself ecumenical goals embracing the whole earth. The former morality, namely Kant's, demanded of the individual actions which one desired of all men: that was a very naive thing; as if everyone knew without further ado what mode of action would benefit the whole of mankind, that is, what actions at all are desirable; it is a theory like that of free trade, presupposing that universal harmony must result of itself in accordance with innate laws of progress. Perhaps some future survey of the requirements of mankind will show that it is absolutely not desirable that all men should act in the same way, but rather that in the interest of ecumenical goals whole tracts of mankind ought to have special, perhaps under certain circumstances even evil tasks imposed upon them. - In any event, if mankind is not to destroy itself through such conscious universal rule, it must first of all attain to a hitherto altogether unprecedented knowledge of the preconditions of culture as a scientific standard for ecumenical goals. Herein lies the tremendous task facing the great spirits of the coming century. Reaction as progress. Sometimes there appear blunt and forceful spirits - capable of exciting great enthusiasm whose development is nonetheless retarded, so that they conjure up again an earlier phase of mankind: they serve to prove that the modern tendencies against which they act are not yet strong enough, that there is something lacking in them: otherwise the latter would be able to offer better resistance to these conjurers. Thus Luther's Reformation, for example, witnesses that in his century all the

impulses to freedom of spirit were still uncertain, tender and youthful; science was as yet unable to raise its head. The whole Renaissance, H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N indeed, seems like an early spring almost snowed away again. But in our century, too, Schopenhauer's metaphysics demonstrates that even now the scientific spirit is not yet sufficiently strong: so that, although all the dogmas of Christianity have long since been demolished, the whole medieval Christian conception of the world and of the nature of man could in Schopenhauer's teaching celebrate a resurrection. Much science resounds in his teaching, but what dominates it is not science but the old familiar 'metaphysical need'. One of the greatest, indeed quite invaluable advantages we derive from Schopenhauer is that through him our sensibilities are for a time compelled to return to older ways of contemplating the world and mankind that once held sway which we would otherwise have no easy access to. The gain for historical justice is very great: I believe that no one would find it easy to do justice to Christianity and its Asiatic relations without Schopenhauer's assistance: on the basis of present-day Christianity alone it would be quite impossible. Only after this great triumph of justice, only after we have corrected the mode of historical interpretation introduced by the Age of Enlightenment on so essential a point as this, may we bear the banner of the Enlightenment - the banner bearing the three names Petrarch, * Erasmus, t Voltaire - further onward. Out of reaction we have created progress. Substitute for religion. One believes one is commending a philosophy - when one presents it as a popular substitute for religion. The economy of the spirit does indeed occasionally require transitional orders of ideas; thus the passage from religion to a scientific mode of thought is a violent and perilous leap, something to be advised against. To that extent this recommendation of a philosophy is justified. But in the end one also has to understand that the needs which religion has satisfied and philosophy is now supposed to satisfy are not immutable; they can be weakened and exterminated. Consider, for example, that Christian distress of mind that comes from sighing over one's inner depravity and care for one's salvation - all conceptions originating in nothing but errors of reason and deserving, not satisfaction, but obliteration. A philosophy can be employed either to satisfy such needs or to set them aside; for they are acquired, time-bound needs resting on presuppositions that contradict those of science. To effect a transition here, to relieve the heart overlaid with feeling, it is much more useful to employ art; for those conceptions we have spoken of will be nourished far less by art than they will be by a metaphysical philosophy. From art it will then be easier to go over to a truly liberating philosophical science. Words in bad odour. - Away with those overused words optimism and pessimism! We have had enough of them. Occasion for using them is growing less day by day; it is only idle chatterers who still have such an • Petrarch: Francesco Petrarch (1304-74): Italian poet and scholar t Erasmus: Desiderius Erasmus (1466-1536):

Dutch humanist OF FIRST AND LAST THINGS indispensable need of them. For why in the world should anyone want to be an optimist if he does not have to defend a God who has to have created the best of worlds if he himself is goodness and perfection - but what thinker still has need of the hypothesis of a God? - But any occasion for a pessimistic creed is likewise lacking, unless one has an interest in provoking the advocates of God, the theologians or the theologizing philosophers, and forcefully asserting the opposite point of view: that evil reigns, that there exists more pain than pleasure, that the world is an artifice, the apparition of an evil will to live. But who still bothers about theologians - except other theologians? - Disregarding theology and opposition to theology, it is quite obvious that the world is neither good nor evil, let alone the best of all or the worst of all worlds, and that these concepts 'good' and 'evil' possess meaning only when applied to men, and perhaps even here are, as they are usually employed, unjustified: in any event, we must cast off both that conception of the world that inveighs against it and that which glorifies it. Drunk with the odour of blossoms. - The ship of mankind has, one believes, a deeper and deeper draught the more heavily it is laden; one believes that the more profoundly a man thinks, the more tenderly he feels, the more highly he rates himself, the greater the distance grows between him and the other animals - the more he appears as the genius among animals the closer he will get to the true nature of the world and to a knowledge of it: this he does in fact do through science, but he thinks he does so even more through his arts and religions. These are, to be sure, a blossom of the world, but they are certainly not closer to the roots of the world than the stern is: they provide us with no better understanding of the nature of things at all, although almost everyone believes they do. It is error that has made mankind so profound, tender, inventive as to produce such a flower as the arts and religions. Pure knowledge would have been incapable of it. Anyone who unveiled to us the nature of the world would produce for all of us the most unpleasant disappointment. It is not the world as thing in itself, it is the world as idea (as error) that is so full of significance, profound, marvellous, and bearing in its womb all happiness and unhappiness. This consequence leads to a philosophy of logical world-denial: which can, however, be united with a practical worldaffirmation just as easily as with its opposite. Bad habits in drawing conclusions. - The commonest erroneous conclusions drawn by mankind are these: a thing exists, therefore it has a right to. Here the conclusion is from the capacity to live to the fitness to live, from the fitness to live to the right to live. Then: an opinion makes happy, therefore it is a true opinion, its effect is good, therefore it itself is good and true. Here the effect is accorded the predicate beneficent, good, in the sense of useful, and then the cause is furnished with the same predicate good, but here in the sense of the logically valid. The reverse of these HUMAN, ALL TOO HUMAN propositions is: a thing

cannot prevail, preserve itself, therefore it is wrong; an opinion causes pain and agitation, therefore it is false. The free spirit, who is all too often acquainted with the erroneousness of this kind of reasoning and has to suffer from its consequences, often succumbs to the temptation to draw the opposite conclusions, which are of course in general equally erroneous: a thing cannot prevail, therefore it is good; an opinion causes pain and distress, therefore it is true. The illogical necessary. Among the things that can reduce a thinker to - despair is the knowledge that the illogical is a necessity for mankind, and that much good proceeds from the illogical. It is implanted so firmly in the passions, in language, in art, in religion, and in general in everything that lends value to life, that one cannot pull it out of these fair things without mortally injuring them. Only very naive people are capable of believing that the nature of man could be transformed into a purely logical one; but if there should be degrees of approximation to this objective, what would not have to be lost if this course were taken! Even the most rational man from time to time needs to recover nature, that is to say his illogical original relationship with all things. Injustice necessary. - All judgements as to the value of life have evolved illogically and are therefore unjust. The falsity of human judgement derives firstly from the condition of the material to be judged, namely very incomplete, secondly from the way in which the sum is arrived at on the basis of this material, and thirdly from the fact that every individual piece of this material is in turn the outcome of false knowledge, and is so with absolute necessity. Our experience of another person, for example, no matter how close he stands to us, can never be complete, so that we would have a logical right to a total evaluation of him; all evaluations are premature and are bound to be. Finally, the standard by which we measure, our own being, is not an unalterable magnitude, we are subject to moods and fluctuations, and yet we would have to know ourselves as a fixed standard to be able justly to assess the relation between ourselves and anything else whatever. Perhaps it would follow from all this that one ought not to judge at all; if only it were possible to live without evaluating, without having aversions and partialities! - for all aversion is dependent on an evaluation, likewise all partiality. A drive to something or away from something divorced from a feeling one is desiring the beneficial or avoiding the harmful, a drive without some kind of knowing evaluation of the worth of its objective, does not exist in man. We are from the very beginning illogical and thus unjust beings and can recognize this: this is one of the greatest and most irresolvable discords of existence. Error regarding life necessary to life. - Every belief in the value and dignity of life rests on false thinking; it is possible only through the fact that empathy with the universal life and suffering of mankind is very feebly developed in the individual. Even those rarer men who think beyond themselves at all have an eye, not for this universal life, but for fenced-off

portions of it. If one knows how to keep the exceptions principally in view, I mean the greatly gifted and pure of soul, takes their production for the goal of world-evolution and rejoices in the effects they in turn produce, one may believe in the value of life, because then one is overlooking all other men: thinking falsely, that is to say. And likewise if, though one does keep in view all mankind, one accords validity only to one species of drives, the less egoistical, and justifies them in face of all the others, then again one can hope for something of mankind as a whole and to this extent believe in the value of life: thus, in this case too, through falsity of thinking. Whichever of these attitudes one adopts, however, one is by adopting it an exception among men. The great majority endure life without complaining overmuch; they believe in the value of existence, but they do so precisely because each of them exists for himself alone, refusing to step out of himself as those exceptions do: everything outside themselves they notice not at all or at most as a dim shadow. Thus for the ordinary, everyday man the value of life rests solely on the fact that he regards himself more highly than he does the world. The great lack of imagination from which he suffers means he is unable to feel his way into other beings and thus he participates as little as possible in their fortunes and sufferings. He, on the other hand, who really could participate in them would have to despair of the value of life; if he succeeded in encompassing and feeling within himself the total consciousness of mankind he would collapse with a curse on existence - for mankind has as a whole no goal, and the individual man when he regards its total course cannot derive from it any support or comfort, but must be reduced to despair. If in all he does he has before him the ultimate goallessness of man, his actions acquire in his own eyes the character of useless squandering. But to feel thus squandered, not merely as an individual but as humanity as a whole, in the way we behold the individual fruits of nature squandered, is a feeling beyond all other feelings. - But who is capable of such a feeling? Certainly only a poet: and poets always know how to console themselves. In mitigation. - But will our philosophy not thus become a tragedy? Will truth not become inimical to life, to the better man? A question seems to lie heavily on our tongue and yet refuses to be uttered: whether one could consciously reside in untruth? or, if one were obliged to, whether death would not be preferable? For there is no longer any 'ought'; for morality, insofar as it was an 'ought', has been just as much annihilated by our mode of thinking as has religion. Knowledge can allow as motives only pleasure and pain, utility and injury: but how will these motives come to terms with the sense for truth? For they too are in contact with errors (insofar as inclination and aversion and their very unjust assessments H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N are, as we said, the essential determinants of pleasure and pain). The whole of human life is sunk deeply in untruth; the individual cannot draw it up out of this well without thereby growing profoundly disillusioned about his own past, without finding his

present motives, such as that of honour, absurd, and pouring mockery and contempt on the passions which reach out to the future and promise happiness in it. Is it true, is all that remains a mode of thought whose outcome on a personal level is despair and on a theoretical level a philosophy of destruction? - I believe that the nature of the after-effect of knowledge is determined by a man's temperament: in addition to the after-effect described I could just as easily imagine a different one, quite possible in individual instances, by virtue of which a life could arise much simpler and emotionally cleaner than our present life is: so that, though the old motives of violent desire produced by inherited habit would still possess their strength, they would gradually grow weaker under the influence of purifying knowledge. In the end one would live among men and with oneself as in nature, without praising, blaming, contending, gazing contentedly, as though at a spectacle, upon many things for which one formerly felt only fear. One would be free of emphasis, and no longer prodded by the idea that one is only nature or more than nature. For this to happen one would, to be sure, have to possess the requisite temperament, as has already been said: a firm, mild and at bottom cheerful soul, a temper that does not need to be on its guard against malice or sudden outbursts and in whose utterances there is nothing of snarling and sullenness - those familiar tedious qualities of old dogs and men who have long been kept on the leash. A man from whom the ordinary fetters of life have fallen to such an extent that he continues to live only so as to know better must, rather, without envy or vexation be able to forgo much, indeed almost everything upon which other men place value; that free, fearless hovering over men, customs, laws and the traditional evaluations of things must suffice him as the condition he considers most desirable. He is happy to communicate his joy in this condition, and he has, perhaps, nothing else to communicate - which involves, to be sure, one more privation and renunciation. If more is nonetheless desired of him, he will, with a benevolent shake of the head, point to his brother, the free man of action, and perhaps not conceal a certain mockery in doing so: for of his 'freedom' there is a curious tale still to be told.

ON THE HISTORY OF THE MORAL SENSATIONS Advantages of psychological observation. - That reflection on the human, all too human - or, as the learned expression has it: psychological observation - is among the expedients by means of which one can alleviate the burden of living, that practice in this art lends presence of mind in difficult situations and entertainment in tedious circumstances, that one can, indeed, pluck useful maxims from the thorniest and most disagreeable stretches of one's own life and thereby feel a little better: that was believed, that was known - in former centuries. Why has it been forgotten by this century, in which, at least in Germany, indeed in all Europe, poverty in psychological observation is apparent through a hundred signs? Not especially in novels, novellas or philosophical writings - these are the work of exceptional

men; it is already more evident, however, in assessments made of public events and personalities: but the art of psychological dissection and computation is lacking above all in the social life of all classes, in which, while there may be much talk about people, there is none at all about man. But why is the richest and most inoffensive material for conversation neglected in this way? Why does one not even read the great masters of the psychological maxim any more? - for it can be said without any exaggeration that it is hard to find any educated person in Europe who has read Laroche-foucauld* or those related to him in style and spirit, and very much harder to find one who has read them and does not revile them. Even this uncommon reader, however, will probably derive much less pleasure from them than the form they employ ought to give him; for even the most refined head is not in a position to appreciate the art of polishing maxims as it ought to be appreciated if he himself is not drawn to it and has not competed in it. In the absence of such practical instruction, one takes the creation and shaping of maxims to be easier than it is, one does not feel intensely enough the charm and sense of achievement in it. That is why present-day readers of maxims find relatively little to satisfy them, indeed hardly more than a mouthful of pleasantries; so that it is with them as it usually is with observers of cameos: who praise because they cannot love, and are quick to admire but even quicker to go away.)6 Objection. - Or is there a debit side to this proposition that psychological • Laroche-foucauld: Fran-ois, Due de Laroche-foucauld (tt-80): French writer and aphorist. 3 1 H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N observation is one of the means of bestowing charm on existence and relieving and mollifying it? Ought one not to have been sufficiently convinced of the unpleasant consequences of this art to want now deliberately to direct the eyes of anyone in process of formation away from it? A certain blind faith in the goodness of human nature, an innate aversion to the dissection of human actions, a kind of modesty in regard to the nakedness of the soul may indeed be more desirable things for the total happiness of an individual than that psychological perspicacity which may be helpful in particular cases; and perhaps belief in goodness, in virtuous men and actions, in an abundance of impersonal benevolence in the world has in fact made men better, inasmuch as it has made them less mistrustful. If one enthusiastically imitates Plutarch's* heroes and feels a repugnance towards suspiciously probing the motives of their actions, one may not be serving truth but one may well be furthering the wellbeing of human society: psychological error and insensibility in this domain in general promotes humanity, while knowledge of truth perhaps gains for us one more hypothesis such as Laroche-foucauld placed before the first edition of his *Sentences et maximes morales*: 'Ce que le monde nomme vertu n'est d'ordinaire qu'un fantme forme par nos passions a qui on donne un nom honnete pour faire impunement ce qu'on veut.'t Laroche-foucauld and the other French masters of psychical

examination (to whom there has lately been added a German, the author of the Psychological Observations) are like skilful marksmen who again and again hit the bullseye - but it is the bullseye of human nature. Their skill evokes amazement, but in the end a spectator inspired not by the spirit of science but that of philanthropy execrates an art that appears to implant a sense of suspicion and reductionism into the souls of men. Nevertheless. However credit and debit balance may stand: at its present - state as a specific individual science the awakening of moral observation has become necessary, and mankind can no longer be spared the cruel sight of the moral dissecting table and its knives and forceps. For here there rules that science which asks after the origin and history of the so-called moral sensations and which as it progresses has to pose and solve the sociological problems entangled with them: - the older philosophy knows nothing of the latter and has, with paltry evasions, always avoided investigation of the origin and history of the moral sensations. With what consequences is now very clearly apparent, since it has been demonstrated in many instances how the errors of the greatest philosophers usually have their point of departure in a false explanation of certain human actions and sensations; how on the basis of an erroneous • Plutarch: Greek biographer and essayist (c. 46 to c. 127); his Lives contain characterizations of eminent Greeks and Romans. t 'Ce que . . . qu'on veut': That which the world calls virtue is usually nothing but a phantom formed by our passions to which we give an honest name so as to do what we wish with impunity. t The author of the Psychological Observations: Paul Ree, with whom Nietzsche was closely acquainted (the book appeared in 1875)- J ON THE H I S T O R Y OF T H E M O R A L S E N S A T I O N S analysis, for example that of the so-called unegoistic actions, a false ethics is erected, religion and mythological monsters are then in turn called upon to buttress it, and the shadow of these dismal spirits in the end falls across even physics and the entire perception of the world. If, however, it is certain that superficiality in psychological observation has laid the most dangerous traps for human judgement and reasoning and continues to lay them, so now what is required is that perseverance in labour that does not weary of heaping stone upon stone, brick upon brick, what is required is the abstemious courage not to be ashamed of such modest labour and to defy every attempt to disparage it. It is true that countless individual observations regarding the human and all too human have first been discovered and expressed in circles of society accustomed to sacrifice, not to scientific knowledge, but to intellectual coquetry; and the odour of that ancient home of the moral maxim - a very seductive odour has continued to adhere almost inextricably to the whole genre: so that on account of it the scientific man involuntarily evidences a certain distrust of this genre and of its seriousness. But it suffices to point to the consequences: for already it is becoming apparent what results of the most serious description are emerging

from the ground of psychological observation. For what is the principle which one of the boldest and coldest of thinkers, the author of the book *On the Origin of the Moral Sensations*,* arrived at by virtue of his incisive and penetrating analyses of human action? 'Moral man', he says, 'stands no closer to the intelligible (metaphysical) world than does physical man'. This proposition, hardened and sharpened beneath the hammer-blow of historical knowledge, may perhaps at some future time serve as the axe which is laid at the root of the 'metaphysical need' of man - whether as more of a blessing than a curse to the general wellbeing, who can say? - but in any event as a proposition with the weightiest consequences; at once fruitful and fearful and looking out upon the world with that Janus-face possessed by all great perceptions. To what extent useful. - Thus: whether psychological observation is more advantageous or disadvantageous to man may remain undecided; what is certain, however, is that it is necessary, because science cannot dispense with it. Science, however, knows no regard for final objectives, just as nature knows nothing of it: but, as the latter occasionally brings into existence things of the greatest appropriateness and usefulness without having willed them, so genuine science, as the imitation of nature in concepts, will also occasionally, indeed frequently promote the wellbeing of mankind and achieve what is appropriate and useful - but likewise without having willed it. He who finds the breath of such a way of thinking too wintry for him perhaps has merely too little fire in him: if he cares to look around him, • The author of the book *On the Origin of the Moral Sensations*: again Paul Ree; the book, which is Ree's chief work, was written during 1844-47 in the house in Sorrento in which Nietzsche was at the same time writing *Human, All Too Human*. *HUMAN, ALL TOO HUMAN* however, he will perceive illnesses that require icepacks, and people so 'compounded together' of fire and spirit they are hard put to it to find air cold and cutting enough for them. Moreover: just as individuals and nations too much given to seriousness have a need of frivolity, just as others too excitable and emotional require from time to time the pressure of a heavy burden if they are to stay healthy, ought we, the more spiritual men of an age which is visibly becoming more and more ignited, not to seize hold on every means there is of extinguishing and cooling, so that we can remain at least as steady, inoffensive and moderate as we still are, and thus perhaps one day be able to serve this age as its mirror and selfreflection? - The fable of intelligible freedom. • - The principal stages in the history of the sensations by virtue of which we make anyone accountable for his actions, that is to say, of the moral sensations, are as follows. First of all, one calls individual actions good or bad quite irrespective of their motives but solely on account of their useful or harmful consequences. Soon, however, one forgets the origin of these designations and believes that the quality 'good' and 'evil' is inherent in the actions themselves, irrespective of their consequences: thus committing the same

error as that by which language designates the stone itself as hard, the tree itself as green - that is to say, by taking for cause that which is effect. Then one consigns the being good or being evil to the motives and regards the deeds in themselves as morally ambiguous. One goes further and accords the predicate good or evil no longer to the individual motive but to the whole nature of a man out of whom the motive grows as the plant does from the soil. Thus one successively makes men accountable for the effects they produce, then for their actions, then for their motives, and finally for their nature. Now one finally discovers that this nature, too, cannot be accountable, inasmuch as it is altogether a necessary consequence and assembled from the elements and influence of things past and present: that is to say, that man can be made accountable for nothing, not for his nature, nor for his motives, nor for his actions, nor for the effects he produces. One has thereby attained to the knowledge that the history of the moral sensations is the history of an error, the error of accountability, which rests on the error of freedom of will. - Schopenhauer concluded otherwise, thus: because certain actions bring after them a feeling of displeasure ('consciousness of guilt'), there must exist a sense of accountability; for there would be no ground for this feeling of displeasure if not only were all the actions of man determined by necessity - which is in fact the case, a view also held by this philosopher - but man himself acquired his entire nature with this same necessity - which Schopenhauer denies. From the fact of that feeling of displeasure Schopenhauer believes he can demonstrate a freedom which man must have acquired somehow, not in • Schopenhauer adhered to Kant's concept of intelligible freedom and defends it in *On the Basis of Morality*, ch. 2 section to. ON THE HISTORY OF THE MORAL SENSATIONS respect of his actions but in respect to his nature: freedom to be thus or thus, that is to say, not to act thus or thus. From the esse, • the sphere of freedom and accountability, there follows in his opinion the operari - the sphere of strict causality, necessity and unaccountability. That feeling of displeasure appears to relate to the operari, to be sure - to that extent it is in error - in truth, however, to the esse, which is the deed of the free will, the basic cause of the existence of an individual: man becomes that which he wills to become, his willing precedes his existence. - Here the erroneous conclusion is drawn that from the fact of a feeling of displeasure there can be inferred the justification, the rational admissibility of this feeling of displeasure; and from this erroneous conclusion Schopenhauer arrives at his fantastic concept of so-called intelligible freedom. But a feeling of displeasure after a deed is absolutely not obliged to be rational; on the contrary, it cannot be, since it rests precisely on the erroneous presupposition that that deed need not have taken place of necessity. Thus: it is because man regards himself as free, not because he is free, that he feels remorse and pangs of conscience. - This feeling is, moreover, something one can disaccustom oneself to, and many people do not feel it at all

in respect of actions which evoke it in others. It is a very changeable thing, tied to the evolution of morality and culture and perhaps present in only a relatively brief span of world-history. - No one is accountable for his deeds, no one for his nature; to judge is the same thing as to be unjust. This also applies when the individual judges himself. The proposition is as clear as daylight, and yet here everyone prefers to retreat back into the shadows and untruth: from fear of the consequences. The over-animal. - The beast in us wants to be lied to; morality is an official lie told so that it shall not tear us to pieces. Without the errors that repose in the assumptions of morality man would have remained animal. As it is, he has taken himself for something higher and imposed sterner laws upon himself. That is why he feels a hatred for the grades that have remained closer to animality: which is the explanation of the contempt formerly felt for the slave as a non-man, as a thing. The unalterable character.:t. - That the character is unalterable is not in the strict sense true; this favourite proposition means rather no more than that, during the brief lifetime of a man, the effective motives are unable to scratch deeply enough to erase the imprinted script of many millennia. If one imagines a man of eighty-thousand years, however, one would have in him a character totally alterable: so that an abundance of different individuals would evolve out of him one after the other. The brevity of human life misleads us to many erroneous assertions regarding the qualities of man. • esse: being t operari: action, manner of acting t The view that character is unalterable was held insistently by Schopenhauer; see his Essay on the Freedom of the Will, ch. 3. H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N The order of desirable things and morality. - The accepted order of rank of desirable things, according to whether a low, higher or highest egoism desires the one or the other, now determines whether one is moral or immoral. To prefer a low-esteemed thing (sensual pleasure, for example) to a more highly valued one (health, for example) counts as immoral; as does preferring luxury to freedom. But the order of rank of desirable things is not firm and the same at all times; if someone prefers revenge to justice, according to the standard of an earlier culture he is moral, according to that of ours immoral. 'Immoral' therefore means that one is not yet, or not yet sufficiently sensible of the higher, more refined, more spiritual motives which a new culture has introduced: it designates one who is retarded, has remained behind, though always it is only a matter of degree. - The order of rank of desirable things itself is not erected or altered in accordance with moral considerations; but once it has been established it then determines whether an action is moral or immoral. Cruel men as retarded men. - We have to regard men who are cruel as stages of earlier cultures which have remained behind: the deeper formations in the mountain of mankind which are otherwise hidden are here for once laid open. They are retarded men whose brain has, through some chance or other in the course of hereditary transmission, failed to develop in as

sensitive and multifarious a way as is normal. They show us what we all were, and fill us with horror: but they themselves are as little accountable for it as a piece of granite is for being granite. Just as certain human organs recall the stage of evolution of the fish, so there must also be in our brain grooves and convolutions that correspond to that cast of mind: but these grooves and convolutions are no longer the riverbed along which the stream of our sensibility runs. Gratitude and revenge. - The reason the man of power is grateful is this. His benefactor has, through the help he has given him, as it were laid hands on the sphere of the man of power and intruded into it: now, by way of requital, the man of power in turn lays hands on the sphere of his benefactor through the act of gratitude. It is a milder form of revenge. If he did not have the compensation of gratitude, the man of power would have appeared unpowerful and thenceforth counted as such. That is why every community of the good, that is to say originally the powerful, places gratitude among its first duties. Swift suggested that men are grateful in the same degree as they are revengeful. Twofold prehistory of good and evil. - The concept good and evil has a two- fold prehistory: firstly in the soul of the ruling tribes and castes. He who has the power to requite, good with good, evil with evil, and also actually ON THE HISTORY OF THE MORAL SENSATIONS practises requital - is, that is to say, grateful and revengeful - is called good; he who is powerless and cannot requite counts as bad. As a good man one belongs to the 'good', a community which has a sense of belonging together because all the individuals in it are combined with one another through the capacity for requital. As a bad man one belongs to the 'bad', to a swarm of subject, powerless people who have no sense of belonging together. The good are a caste, the bad a mass like grains of sand. Good and bad is for a long time the same thing as noble and base, master and slave. On the other hand, one does not regard the enemy as evil: he can requite. In Homer the Trojan and the Greek are both good. It is not he who does us harm but he who is contemptible who counts as bad. In the community of the good goodness is inherited; it is impossible that a bad man could grow up out of such good soil. If, however, one of the good should do something unworthy of the good, one looks for excuses; one ascribes the guilt to a god, for example, by saying he struck the good man with madness and rendered him blind. - Then in the soul of the subjected, the powerless. Here every other man, whether he be noble or base, counts as inimical, ruthless, cruel, cunning, ready to take advantage. Evil is the characterizing expression for man, indeed for every living being one supposes to exist, for a god, for example; human, divine mean the same thing as diabolical, evil. Signs of goodness, benevolence, sympathy are received fearfully as a trick, a prelude with a dreadful termination, a means of confusing and outwitting, in short as refined wickedness. When this disposition exists in the individual a community can hardly arise, at best the most

rudimentary form of community: so that wherever this conception of good and evil reigns the downfall of such individuals, of their tribes and races, is near. - Our present morality has grown up in the soil of the ruling tribes and castes. Sympathy more painful than suffering. - There are cases in which sympathy for suffering is more painful than actual suffering. We find it more painful, for example, when one of our friends makes himself guilty of something shameful than when we do so ourselves. For we believe, firstly, in the purity of his character more than he does: then, probably precisely on account of this belief, our love for him is stronger than his own love for himself. Even if his egoism really does suffer more than our egoism does, inasmuch as he has to endure the evil consequences of his act more than we do, nonetheless the unegoistic in us - this word is never to be taken in a strict sense but only as a simplified form of expression - is affected more strongly by his guilt than is the unegoistic in him. Hypochondria. - There are people who out of empathy with and concern for another person become hypochondriac; the species of sympathy that arises in this case is nothing other than an Ulness. Thus there is also a Christian hypochondria such as overcomes those solitary, religiously H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N inclined people who have the suffering and death of Christ continually before their eyes. Economy of goodness. - Goodness and love as the most salutary medicine in traffic between men are such precious inventions one could well wish they might be employed as economically as possible: but this is impossible. Economy of goodness is the dream of the boldest utopians. Benevolence. - Among the little but immeasurably frequent and thus very influential things to which science ought to pay more attention than to the great, rare things, benevolence too is to be reckoned; I mean those social expressions of a friendly disposition, those smiles of the eyes, those handclaps, that comfortable manner with which almost all human action is as a rule encompassed. Every teacher, every official brings this addition to what he does as a matter of duty; it is the continual occupation of humanity, as it were its light-waves in which everything grows; especially within the narrowest circle, within the family, is life made to flourish only through this benevolence. Good-naturedness, friendliness, politeness of the heart are never-failing emanations of the unegoistic drive and have played a far greater role in the construction of culture than those much more celebrated expressions of it called pity, compassion and self-sacrifice. But usually they are neglected and undervalued; and there is, indeed, very little of the unegoistic in them. The sum of these small doses is nonetheless enormous; their collective force is among the mightiest of forces. - One can likewise discover much more happiness in the world than clouded eyes can see: one can do so if one calculates correctly and does not overlook all those moments of pleasure in which every day of even the most afflicted human life is rich. The desire to excite pity. Larochefoucauld is certainly right when, in the - most noteworthy

passage of his self-portrait (first printed 1658), he warns all those who possess reason against pity, when he advises that it be left to those people of the commonality who (because their actions are not determined by reason) require the passions if they are to be brought to the point of aiding a sufferer or energetically intervening in a case of misfortune; while pity, in his (and Plato's) judgement, enfeebles the soul. One should, to be sure, manifest pity, but take care not to possess it; for the unfortunate are so stupid that the manifestation of pity constitutes for them the greatest good in the world. - Perhaps one can warn even more strongly against this having pity if one understands this need felt by the unfortunate, not precisely as stupidity and intellectual deficiency, as a kind of mental disturbance that misfortune brings with it (that, indeed, is how Larochefoucauld seems to conceive it), but as something quite different and more suspicious. Observe children who weep and wail in order that they shall be pitied, and therefore wait for the moment when their condition will be noticed; live among invalids and the mentally afflicted ON THE HISTORY OF THE MORAL SENSATIONS and ask yourself whether their eloquent moaning and complaining, their displaying of misfortune, does not fundamentally have the objective of hurting those who are with them: the pity which these then express is a consolation for the weak and suffering, inasmuch as it shows them that, all their weakness notwithstanding, they possess at any rate one power: the power to hurt. In this feeling of superiority of which the manifestation of pity makes him conscious, the unfortunate man gains a sort of pleasure; in the conceit of his imagination he is still of sufficient importance to cause affliction in the world. The thirst for pity is thus a thirst for self-enjoyment, and that at the expense of one's fellow men; it displays man in the whole ruthlessness of his own dear self: but not precisely in his 'stupidity', as Larochefoucauld thinks. - In the conversations of social life, three-quarters of all questions are asked, three-quarters of all answers given, in order to cause just a little pain to the other party; that is why many people have such a thirst for social life: it makes them aware of their strength. In such countless but very small doses in which malice makes itself felt it is a powerful stimulant to life: just as benevolence, disseminated through the human world in the same form, is the ever available medicine. - But will there be many honest men prepared to admit that causing pain gives pleasure? that one not seldom entertains oneself and entertains oneself well - by mortifying other people, at least in one's own mind, and by firing off at them the grapeshot of petty malice? Most are too dishonest, and a few too good, to know anything of this pudendum; ♦ and they are welcome to deny if they like that Prosper Merimeet is right when he says: 'Sachez aussi qu'il n'y a rien de plus commun que de faire le mal pour le plaisir de le faire.' :f: How appearance becomes being. - Even when in the deepest distress, the actor ultimately cannot cease to think of the impression he and the

whole scenic effect is making, even for example at the burial of his own child; he will weep over his own distress and the ways in which it expresses itself, as his own audience. The hypocrite who always plays one and the same role finally ceases to be a hypocrite; for example priests, who as young men are usually conscious or unconscious hypocrites, finally become natural and then really are priests without any affectation; or if the father fails to get that far then perhaps the son does so, employing his father's start and inheriting his habits. If someone obstinately and for a long time wants to appear something it is in the end hard for him to be anything else. The profession of almost every man, even that of the artist, begins with hypocrisy, with an imitation from without, with a copying of what is most effective. He who is always wearing a mask of a friendly countenance must finally acquire a power over benevolent moods without which

- *pudedum*: shameful part

t Prosper Merimee (180-70): French writer, the author of *Carmen*

t 'Sachez aussi . . . de le faire': Know, too, that there is nothing more common than to do evil for the pleasure of doing it. H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N the impression of friendliness cannot be obtained - and finally these acquire power over him, he is benevolent. The point of honesty in deception. - With all great deceivers there is a noteworthy occurrence to which they owe their power. In the actual act of deception, with all its preparations, its enthralling in voice, expression and gesture, in the midst of the scenery designed to give it effect, they are overcome by belief in themselves: it is this which then speaks so miraculously and compellingly to those who surround them. The founders of religions are distinguished from these great deceivers by the fact that they never emerge from this state of self-deception: or very rarely they experience for once that moment of clarity when doubt overcomes them; usually, however, they comfort themselves by ascribing these moments of clarity to the evil antagonist. Self-deception has to exist if a grand effect is to be produced. For men believe in the truth of that which is plainly strongly believed. Supposed stages of truth. - One of the commonest false conclusions is this: because someone is true and honest towards us, he speaks the truth. Thus a child believes in the judgements of its parents, the Christian in the assertions of the founder of the Church. There is likewise a disinclination to admit that all that which men have defended in earlier centuries with sacrifice of happiness and life were nothing but errors: perhaps one says they were stages of truth. But what one thinks at bottom is that, if someone has honestly believed in something and has fought and died for his belief, it would be altogether too unfair if what had inspired him had actually been no more than an error. Such an event seems to go against eternal justice; which is why the heart of sensitive people again and again contradicts their head, and decrees: there absolutely must exist a necessary connection between moral action and intellectual insight. Unhappily it is otherwise; for there is no such thing as eternal justice. The lie. - Why do almost all people tell the truth in

ordinary everyday life? - Certainly not because a god has forbidden them to lie. The reason is, firstly because it is easier; for lying demands invention, dissimulation and a good memory. (Which is why Swift says that he who tells a lie seldom realizes what a heavy burden he has assumed; for, in order to maintain a lie, he has to invent twenty more.) Then because, in straightforward relationships, it is advantageous to say: I want this, I have done that, and things of that kind; because, that is to say, the route of authority and compulsion is more certain than that of cunning. - If, however, a child should have been brought up in complicated domestic circumstances, it is just as natural for him to employ the lie and involuntarily always to say that which serves his interests; a sense of truth, an aversion to lying as such, is quite foreign and inaccessible to him, and thus he lies in all innocence.

ON THE HISTORY OF THE MORAL SENSATIONS

Casting suspicion on morality on account of faith. - No power could maintain itself if its advocates were nothing but hypocrites; however many 'worldly' elements it may possess, the strength of the Catholic Church rests on those priestly natures, still very numerous, whose lives are hard and full of meaning and whose glance and wasted bodies speak of nightwatches, fasting, fervent prayer, perhaps even of flagellation; these men deeply affect other men and inspire them with fear: what if it were needful to live thus? - that is the dreadful question the sight of them lays on the tongue. By propagating this doubt they continually establish further pillars of their power; even the free-thinkers do not dare to confront the man selfless in this way with a harsh sense of truth and say to him: 'Deceived yourself, cease to deceive!' - It is only difference in insight that divides them from him, certainly no difference as regards goodness or badness; but what one does not like one usually also treats unjustly. Thus one speaks of the cunning and infamous arts of the Jesuits, but overlooks what self-overcoming every individual Jesuit imposes upon himself and that the alleviated practice of life preached by the Jesuit textbooks is intended for the benefit of the laity, not for their own. One may ask, indeed, whether, given quite the same tactics and organization, we children of the Enlightenment would be equally good instruments or equally admirable in self-conquest, indefatigability or devotedness. Victory of knowledge over radical evil. - He who wants to become wise will profit greatly from at some time having harboured the idea that mankind is fundamentally evil and corrupt: it is a false idea, as is its opposite; but it enjoyed dominance throughout whole ages of history, and its roots have branched out even into us ourselves and our world. To understand ourselves we must understand it; but if we are then ourselves to rise higher, we must rise up above it. We then come to recognize that there is no such thing as sin in the metaphysical sense; but, in the same sense, no such thing as virtue either; that this whole domain of moral ideas is in a state of constant fluctuation, that there exist higher and deeper conceptions of good and evil, of moral and immoral. He

who desires little more of things than knowledge of them easily finds repose of soul and if he blunders (or, as the world puts it, sins), it will at most be through ignorance but hardly out of covetousness. He will no longer want to decry the desires as heretical and to exterminate them; but the only goal which completely dominates him, at all times to know as fully as possible, will make him cool and soothe everything savage in his disposition. Moreover, he will have got free of a host of tormenting ideas, the expressions 'pains of Hell', 'sinfulness', 'incapacity for good' will no longer have any effect on him: he will recognize in them only the hovering phantoms of false ways of viewing life and the world. Morality as the self-division of man . A good author whose heart is really in - H U M A N , A L L T O O H U M A N his subject wishes that someone would come and annihilate him by presenting the same subject with greater clarity and resolving all the questions contained in it. A girl in love wishes the faithfulness and devotion of her love could be tested by the faithlessness of the man she loves. A soldier wishes he could fall on the battlefield for his victorious fatherland; for his supreme desire is victor in the victory of his fatherland. A mother gives to her child that of which she deprives herself, sleep, the best food, if need be her health, her strength. - But are these all unegoistic states? Are these deeds of morality miracles because they are, in Schopenhauer's words, 'impossible and yet real'? Is it not clear that in all these instances man loves something of himself, an idea, a desire, an offspring, more than something else of himself, that he thus divides his nature and sacrifices one part of it to the other? Is it something essentially different from when some obstinate man says: 'I would rather be shot down than move an inch out of that fellow's way?' - The inclination for something (wish, impulse, desire) is present in all the above-mentioned instances; to give in to it, with all the consequences, is in any event not 'unegoistic'. - In morality man treats himself not as individuum but as dividuum.* What one can promise. - One can promise actions but not feelings; for the latter are involuntary. He who promises someone he will always love him or always hate him or always be faithful to him, promises something that does not reside in his power; but he can certainly promise to perform actions which, though they are usually the consequences of love, hatred, faithfulness, can also derive from other motives: for several paths and motives can lead to the same action. To promise always to love someone therefore means: for as long as I love you I shall render to you the actions of love; if I cease to love you, you will continue to receive the same actions from me, though from other motives: so that in the heads of our fellow men the appearance will remain that love is still the same and unchanged. - One therefore promises the continuation of the appearance of love when one swears to someone ever-enduring love without selfdeception. Intellect and morality. - One has to have a good memory if one is to keep a promise. One has to have a powerful imagination if one is to feel sympathy. So closely is

morality tied to the quality of the intellect. 6o Revenge and the desire to revenge. To desire to revenge and then to carry - out revenge means to be the victim of a vehement attack of fever which then, however, passes: but to desire to revenge without possessing the strength and courage to carry out revenge means to carry about a chronic illness, a poisoning of body and soul. Morality, which looks only at inten- • Terms of Scholastic philosophy: individuum: that which cannot be divided without destroying its essence, divdium: that which is composite and lacks an individual essence ON THE H I S T O R Y O F T H E M O R A L S E N S A T I O N S tions, assesses both cases equally; in the ordinary way the former case is assessed as being the worse (on account of the evil consequences which the act of revenge will perhaps produce). Both evaluations are shortsighted. 6t The ability to wait. - Ability to wait is so difficult an accomplishment that the greatest poets have not disdained to make inability to wait a motif of their poems. Thus did Shakespeare in Othello, Sophocles in Ajax: if the latter had only allowed his feelings to cool for one more day his suicide would no longer have appeared necessary, as is indicated by the oracle; probably he would have snapped his fingers at the horrible promptings of his wounded vanity and said to himself: who in my situation would not have mistaken a sheep for a hero? is it something so very terrible? On the contrary, it is something anyone would do: Ajax could console himself with such a reflection as that. Passion will not wait; the tragic element in the life of great men often lies not in their conflicts with their age and with the lowness of their fellow men, but in their inability to put off their work for a year or two years; they cannot wait. - In all cases of duels, the seconds have the duty to determine whether the contestants cannot wait: if they cannot then a duel is reasonable, inasmuch as each of them says to himself: 'either I live on, in which event he dies this instant, or the other way round'. In such a case waiting would mean protracting the torments of wounded honour in the face of him who has wounded it, and this can be more painful than life is worth. Revelling in revenge. - Uncultivated people who feel insulted are accustomed to set the degree of insultingness as high as possible and to recount the cause of the insult in strongly exaggerated terms, so as to be able really to revel in the feeling of hatred and revengefulness thus engendered. Value of diminution. - There are not a few people (perhaps it is even most people) who, in order to maintain in themselves a sense of self-respect and a certain efficiency in action, are obliged to disparage and diminish in their minds all the other people they know. Since, however, petty natures are in the majority,

Part IV

Daybreak: Thoughts on the Prejudices of Morality

1881 — Translated by R.J. Hollingdale

Contents Introduction VB Chronology XXXV Further reading xxxviii Editors' note xlii Daybreak: Thoughts on the prejudices of morality Preface Book! Book II Book III Book IV Book V 1 79 Notes Index Introduction The place of Daybreak in the Nietzschean corpus Nietzsche began compiling the notes that would comprise Daybreak in January of 1880, finishing the book by May of the following year. Like all of Nietzsche's books, it sold poorly (fewer than 250 copies in the first five years, according to William Schaberg). Unlike most of his other works, however, it has been sadly neglected during the Nietzsche renaissance of the past three decades. Daybreak post-dates his famous, polemical study of classical literature, *The Birth of Tragedy* (1872) the book that, at the time, destroyed Nietzsche's professional reputation in classical philology (the subject he taught at the University of Basel, until ill health forced his retirement in 1879). Daybreak also post-dates a somewhat less-neglected prior volume, *Human, All Too Human: A Book for Free spirits* (1878-80), the book often said to constitute the highwater mark of Nietzsche's "positivist" phase (in which he accepted, somewhat uncritically, that science was the paradigm of all genuine knowledge). Daybreak's relative obscurity, however, is due more to his subsequent writings, which have overshadowed it in both the classroom and the secondary literature: *The Gay Science* (1882), the four books of *Thus Spoke Zarathustra* (1883-84), *Beyond Good and Evil* (1886), *On the Genealogy of Morality* (1887), and, to a lesser extent, the works of his last sane year (1888): *Twilight of the Idols*, *The Antichrist*, and *Ecce Homo*. Even the compilation made (against Nietzsche's wishes) from his notebooks after his mental collapse (in January 1889) and subsequently published as *The Will to Power* (first German edition, 1901) has received more scholarly scrutiny than Daybreak a book Nietzsche intended to publish, and one - that he pronounced (in late 1888) the "book [in which] my campaign against morality begins" (*Ecce Homo*, "Why I Write Such Good Books," sub-section 1 of section on Daybreak).¹ This last observation is of crucial importance: for as he goes on to tell us in the same passage, Daybreak "seeks [a] new morning . . . [i]n a revaluation of all values, in a liberation from all moral values." The book,

in short, marks the beginning of Nietzsche's central philosophical project: a revaluation of all values, a thorough-going critique of morality itself. It is the book that broaches " [t] he question concerning the origin of moral values" (ibid.), the question he returns to in *Beyond Good and Evil* (esp. Section 260) and, most famously, in the *Genealogy*. More importantly, it is the book that first develops in a substantial way themes that mark the "mature" Nietzsche: for example, his critique of the conventional view of human agency, as well as his development of a "naturalistic" conception of persons. That it is a serious mistake to neglect *Daybreak*, and that this new edition presents a splendid opportunity for students and scholars to reconsider its central place in the corpus, we hope will become apparent in the following pages. We also hope to demonstrate how wrong-headed is the following common view of *Daybreak*, most recently expressed by the editors of *The Cambridge Companion to Nietzsche*: "Nietzsche seems bent [in *Daybreak*] on conveying a particular type of experience in thinking to his readers, much more than he is concerned to persuade his readers to adopt any particular point of view." Nietzsche's ambitions are, we will show, far more philosophically substantial, as would befit the book in which Nietzsche's "campaign against morality" begins. First, however, we must set the intellectual stage on which *Daybreak* enters. Nietzsche and Nietzsche's Germany

The widespread pedagogic practice of treating Nietzsche as a figure of "nineteenth-century philosophy," along with Hegel and Marx, actually does considerable violence to the real intellectual

1 We will generally refer to Nietzsche's texts by their standard English-language acronyms: D=*Daybreak*; HA=*Human, All Too Human*; BGE=*Beyond Good and Evil*; GM=*On the Genealogy of Morality*; EH=*Ecce Homo*. Roman numerals refer to major parts or chapters; Arabic numerals refer to sections, not pages.

VIII I NTRO DUCTIO N

history of Germany. While Hegel did dominate German philosophical life in the first quarter of the century, by 1830 his influence was waning seriously. By the 1840s and 1850s, Hegel's critics - Karl Marx, Arthur Schopenhauer, and Ludwig Feuerbach, among others - were both better known and more widely read than Hegel. By the time Nietzsche (born 1844) was being educated at the post-secondary level, it was not Hegel's Idealism that dominated the intellectual landscape, but rather Schopenhauer's own more Kantian metaphysical system, as well as the broad-based intellectual movement known as "German Materialism," of which Feuerbach was an early figure. (There is no evidence, however, that Nietzsche ever read Marx, who was not himself part of the "Materialist" movement at issue here.) For purposes of understanding Nietzsche, the key German figures are really Kant, Schopenhauer, and the Materialists. Nietzsche, of course, was trained not in philosophy per se, but in classical philology, the exacting study of the texts and cultures of the ancient world. Unlike contemporary literary theorists, nineteenth-century German classicists viewed

the interpretation of texts as a science, whose aim was to discover what texts really mean through an exhaustive study of language, culture and context. Nietzsche proved a brilliant student, and was awarded a professorship in 1869, even before earning his doctorate. Yet Nietzsche was always ill-at-ease with the narrow academic horizons of professional philology. He sought to do more than solve mere scholarly "puzzles"; he wanted to connect the study of classical civilization to his far more pressing concern with the state of contemporary German culture. It was this project he undertook in *The Birth of Tragedy*, a book that was, not surprisingly, poorly received by his academic peers. Evidence of Nietzsche's classical training and his admiration of classical civilization abounds throughout *Daybreak*. Two themes, in particular, recur. First, Nietzsche embraced the "realism" of the Sophists and Presocratics, philosophers who had the courage, in Nietzsche's view, to look reality in the eye, and report things as they really are, without euphemism or sentimentality. Nietzsche saw, with good reason, the great Greek historian Thucydides as the embodiment of this perspective on human nature and human affairs, noting that in Thucydides, "that culture of the most impartial knowledge of the world finds its last glorious flower: that culture which had in Sophocles its poet, in Pericles its statesman, in Hippocrates its I NTRO DUCTIO N physician, in Democritus its natural philosopher; which deserves to be baptized with the name of its teachers, the Sophists . . ." (168) . Nietzsche himself strives to imitate Thucydides' realistic appraisal of human motivations, for example, when he observes that "egoistic" actions "have hitherto been by far the most frequent actions, and will continue to be so for all future time" (148) . Second, Nietzsche defends the "empiricism" of the Presocratics against the "idealism" of Plato; indeed he sees as fundamental to the whole history of philosophy the dispute between those who accept as the only reality what the "senses" reveal about the world and those who claim that the "real" world exists beyond the sensible world. It is clear where Nietzsche stands on this question. He rejects the "dialectic" method as a way of getting behind "the veil of appearance" - a project he attributes to Plato and Schopenhauer - noting that "For that to which they want to show us the way does not exist" (474) . Elsewhere in *Daybreak*, he observes: "Thus did Plato flee from reality and desire to see things only in pallid mental pictures; he was full of sensibility and knew how easily the waves of his sensibility could close over his reason" (448; cf. 43) . . Here we see a characteristic Nietzschean move (to which we will return shortly) : to explain a particular philosophical position (e.g. Plato's view that the "real" world is the world of "Forms" or "Ideas," that are inaccessible to the senses) in terms of facts about the person who advances the position (e.g. Plato's excessive sensitivity) . These critical remarks about Plato must be balanced with Nietzsche's admiration for Plato's "genius" (497) . Thus, in a remark that remains apt today, Nietzsche contrasts the "Platonic dialogue" in which "souls were filled with drunkenness at

the rigorous and sober game of concept, generalization, refutation, limitation" with "how philosophy is done today" in which philosophers "want to be 'artistic natures'" and to enjoy "the divine privilege of being incomprehensible" (544) . Nietzsche's engagement with the classical world marks just one of the three important intellectual influences on his philosophical writing. The other two were the philosophy of Schopenhauer and the German Materialist movement of the 1850s and 1860s. We shall discuss Schopenhauer's impact on Nietzsche in detail below in the context of Daylbreak's central theme, the critique of morality. Here we introduce some of the main themes of German Materialism. x I NTRO DUCTIO N German Materialism had its origins in Feuerbach's work of the late 1830s and early 1840s, but it really exploded on to the cultural scene in the 1850s, under the impetus of the startling new discoveries about human beings made by the burgeoning science of physiology. The medical doctor Ludwig Buchner summed up the Materialist point of view well in his 1855 best-seller Force and Matter, the book that became the "Bible" of Materialism. "The researches and discoveries of modern times," he wrote in the preface to the eighth edition, "can no longer allow us to doubt that man, with all he has and possesses, be it mental or corporeal, is a natural product like all other organic beings." Our evidence of Nietzsche's familiarity with the Materialists is extensive. For one thing, it is impossible that a literate young person in Germany at the time could have been unfamiliar with the Materialists. As one critic wrote in 1856: "A new world view is settling into the minds of men. It goes about like a virus. Every young mind of the generation now living is affected by it" (quoted in Gregory, Scientific Materialism, p. 10) . More concretely, we do know that Nietzsche read (with great enthusiasm) Friedrich Lange's History of Materialism (published 1866) , a book which mounted an extensive (but sympathetic) NeoKantian critique of the Materialists. In fact, in a letter of February 1868 (quoted in Stack, Lange and Nietzsche, p. 13) , Nietzsche called Lange's book "a real treasure-house," mentioning, among other things, Lange's discussion of the "materialist movement of our times," including the work of Feuerbach, Buchner, and the physiologists Jacob Moleschott and Herman von Helmholtz. From Lange, Nietzsche would have learned of the Materialist view that "The nature of man is . . . only a special case of universal physiology, as thought is only a special case in the chain of the physical processes of life." Indeed, that he took the lesson to heart is suggested in his autobiography, Ecce Homo, where he tells us (in his discussion of Human, All Too Human) that in the late 1870s, "A truly burning thirst took hold of me: henceforth I really pursued nothing more than physiology, medicine and natural science." A bit earlier in the same work (II: 2) , he complains of the "blunder" that he "became a philologist - why not at least a physician or something else that opens one's eyes?" Yet the most compelling evidence of the Materialist impact on Nietzsche is the extent to

which Materialist themes appear in Nietzsche's work, including *Daybreak*. The Materialists embraced the idea that human beings were essentially bodily organisms, *xi* I NTRO DUCTIO N whose attitudes, beliefs, and values were explicable by reference to physiological facts about them. Spiritual, religious, and moral explanations of human beings were to be supplanted by purely physical or physiological explanations. Thus, Moleschott's 1850 work *The Physiology of Food* contained 500 pages of detailed information about the physical and chemical properties of food and human digestion, while his popular companion volume, *The Theory of Food: For the People*, spelled out the implications of this research in terms of the different diets that different types of people need to flourish. In reviewing Moleschott's book, Feuerbach expressed the core idea as follows: "If you want to improve the people then give them better food instead of declamations against sin.. Man is what he eats" (quoted in Gregory, *Scientific Materialism*, p. 92) . Buchner's *Force and Matter* took a related tack, seeking to explain human character and belief systems in physiological terms. So, for example, he suggested that "A copious secretion of bile has, as is well known, a powerful influence on the mental disposition" and arguing elsewhere in the same work that it was, "Newton's atrophied brain [that] caused him in old age to become interested in studying the . . . Bible." With figures like Moleschott and Buchner ascendant on the intellectual scene, it is hardly surprising to find Nietzsche writing as follows in *Daybreak*: Whatever proceeds from the stomach, the intestines, the beating of the heart, the nerves, the bile, the semen - all those distempers, debilitations, excitations, the whole chance operation of the machine of which we still know so little! - had to be seen by a Christian such as Pascal as a moral and religious phenomenon, and he had to ask whether God or Devil, good or evil, salvation or damnation was to be discovered in them! Oh what an unhappy interpreter. (86; cf. 83) Like the Materialists, Nietzsche replaces "moral" or "religious" explanations for phenomena with naturalistic explanations, particularly explanations couched in physiological or quasi-physiological language. Thus, he suggests that "Three-quarters of all the evil done in the world happens out of timidity: and this [is] above all a physiological phenomenon" (538) , and that "our moral judgments and evaluations . . . are only images and fantasies based on a physiological process unknown to us" (1 19) . Indeed, he endorses, as a general explanatory scruple, the view that "all the products of [a *xii* I NTRO DUCTIO N person's] thinking are bound to reflect the condition he is in" (42) , noting, accordingly, that any particular philosophy "translate[s] as it were into reason" what amounts to a "personal diet" (553) . The critique of morality The central theme of *Daybreak* is its attack on morality. The attack proceeds essentially along two fronts. First, Nietzsche takes traditional morality to involve false presuppositions: for example, a false picture of human agency (roughly, the view that human beings

act autonomously or freely, and thus are morally responsible for what they do) . He attacks this picture of agency from the perspective of a naturalistic view of persons as determined in their actions by the fundamental physiological and psychological facts about them. Second, he takes traditional morality to be inhospitable to certain types of human flourishing. This second theme, which is less prominent than the first, is voiced at various points in *Daybreak*: for example, when Nietzsche complains that morality entails "a fundamental remoulding, indeed weakening and abolition of the individual" (1 32) , a result of the fact that "morality is nothing other . . . than obedience to customs" (9) , and thus is incompatible with a "free human being . . . [who] is determined to depend upon himself and not upon a tradition" (9) . A variation on this criticism is also apparent when he observes (contra Rousseau) that "Our weak unmanly, social concepts of good and evil and their tremendous ascendancy over body and soul have finally weakened all bodies and souls and snapped the self-reliant, independent, unprejudiced men, the pillars of a strong civilization . . ." (1 64) . The view that morality poses a special threat to human excellence or greatness is one that will become more prominent in Nietzsche's later works, though it remains visible in this early book as well. Yet the crux of the argument in *Daybreak* is directed at the problematic presuppositions of morality. As he writes in an important passage on two different ways of "denying" morality: "To deny morality" - this can mean, first to deny that the moral motives which men claim have inspired their actions really have done so - it is thus the assertion that morality consists of words and is among the coarser or more subtle deceptions (especially self-deceptions) which men practise Then it can mean: to deny that moral judgments are based on truths. Here it is admitted that xiii I NTRO DUCTIO N they really are motives of action, but that in this way it is errors which, as the basis of all moral judgment, impel men to their moral actions. This is my point of view: though I should be the last to deny that in very many cases there is some ground for suspicion that the other point of view - that is to say, the point of view of La Rochefoucauld and others who think like him - may also be justified and in any event of great general application. Thus I deny morality as I deny alchemy, that is, I deny their presuppositions [die Voraussetzungen, which might also be translated "premises"] : not that countless people feel themselves to be immoral, but there is any true reason so to feel. It goes without saying that I do not deny - unless I am a fool - that many actions called . . . moral ought to be done and encouraged - but I think the one should be encouraged and the other avoided for other reasons than hitherto. We have to learn to think differently - in order at last, perhaps very late on, to attain even more: to feel differently. (D, 103) This important passage is of great value in understanding the argument of *Daybreak*, and we shall have more to say about it, below. Note now, however, the crucial analogy Nietzsche draws between his attack on "morality" and a

comparable attack on alchemy. When we deny alchemy we don't deny that "countless people" believed themselves to be alchemists, that is, believed themselves to be engaged in the process of transforming the base metals into gold. Rather, we deny a presupposition of their undertaking: namely (to put it in modern terms) the presupposition that the application of forces to the macro-properties of substances can effect a transformation in their micro-properties (i.e. their molecular constitution) . So to "deny" morality in a similar fashion is not to deny that people act for moral reasons or that they take morality seriously, but to "deny" that the reasons for which they do so are sound: the presuppositions of morality are as wrong-headed as the presuppositions of alchemy. We return, below, to the crucial question of what are the "presuppositions" of morality in Nietzsche's sense. Before we do so, however, we will sketch those features of the moral philosophies of Kant and Schopenhauer against the background of which Nietzsche came to understand morality as having false presuppositions.

INTRODUCTION Kant and Schopenhauer on morality

According to Kant and Schopenhauer, actions are praiseworthy from the viewpoint of morality only when done from a moral motive. But these philosophers disagree about the character of moral motivation and therefore about which actions have the special kind of value they both call "moral worth" (or "ethical significance," as Schopenhauer sometimes says) . Kant and Schopenhauer agree that an action is devoid of moral worth if it is motivated purely by a desire for the agent's own happiness. But Kant goes further, claiming that desiring the happiness of others "stands on the same footing as other inclinations" and cannot therefore give moral worth to actions (G 398/66) .² His reasoning seems to be that the desire for the happiness of another cannot give an action moral worth if the desire for one's own happiness clearly does not. Inclinations and desires may deserve praise and encouragement, but never esteem, the mark of the moral. Kant considers duty to be the only reasonable alternative to desire or inclination as the source of moral worth. To have moral worth an action must be done from the motive of duty. This means that it is done because one recognizes that one ought to perform the action and that the action is "objectively necessary in itself" regardless of one's own desires or ends (G 414/82) . The action is thus motivated by the recognition of a categorical imperative. If one recognizes an ought statement as a hypothetical imperative, in contrast, one recognizes only a conditioned necessity, the necessity of an action for the achievement of some further end. The shopkeeper recognizes that he ought not cheat his customers because they will buy from his competitors if he does. The necessity he recognizes is thus conditioned by his own end or desire: to run a successful business. In this case, the necessity of the commanded action can be escaped if he abandons the end or purpose, whereas this is not so in the case of a categorical imperative - the necessity it formulates is not dependent on any of the agent's purposes. There is

one purpose Kant thinks we cannot 2 Kant's *Grundlegung zur Metaphysik der Sitten* is cited as "G" followed by the page number in the Academy edition and the page number in H. J. Paton's translation: *The Moral Law: Kant's Groundwork of the Metaphysic of Morals* (London: Hutchinson and Co., 1958). xv I NTRO DUCTIO N abandon, for "we can assume with certainty that all do have [it] by natural necessity": our own happiness. Yet imperatives that affirm the practical necessity of an action as a means to the furtherance of happiness - imperatives of prudence - still count as hypothetical rather than categorical: "an action is commended not absolutely, but only as a means to a further purpose" (c 41 6/83) . To act from the motive of duty, according to Kant, is to act out of reverence for the law: to be motivated sufficiently to perform an action by the recognition of its objective or unconditioned necessity. Schopenhauer denies that Kant's idea of "objective necessity" adds to our understanding of morality, calling it "nothing but a cleverly concealed and very forced paraphrase of the word ought" (BM 67) .3 Arguing that "every ought derives all sense and meaning simply and solely in reference to threatened punishment or promised reward" (BM 55) , he further denies that the recognition of an ought ever involves "unconditioned necessity." The Kantian notions of absolute obligation, law, and duty are derived from theology, he claims, and have no sense or content at all apart from the assumption of a God who gives the law (BM 68) . For we simply can make no sense of the idea of law, and thus of how a law could confer on us duties or obligations, unless we regard obedience as promising reward and disobedience as threatening punishment. Even if we assume that God has laid down a law, Schopenhauer would refuse it moral status. Because even a divine command would acquire the status of law only by being able to promise reward and threaten punishment, it could only be a hypothetical imperative. "Obedience to it is, of course, wise or foolish according to circumstances; yet it will always be selfish, and consequently without moral value" (BM 55) . According to Schopenhauer, then, an ought statement never counts as a categorical imperative or moral judgment, but can only be what Kant would have called a 'Judgment of prudence.' An action performed for the sake of duty, simply because one recognizes that one ought to do it, is selfish rather than morally 3 Schopenhauer's *Die heiden Grundprobleme der Ethik* is cited as "BM," followed by the page number in the translation by E. F. J. Payne: *On the Basis of Morality* (Indianapolis: Bobbs-Merrill, 1965) . Schopenhauer's *Die Welt als Wille und VorsleUungis* cited as "WW," followed by the volume and page number in the translation by E. F. J. Payne: *The World as WiU and Representation* (New York: Dover, 1966) . xvi I NTRO DUCTIO N motivated. Schopenhauer thus argues against Kant within the latter's own terms. If Kant accepted Schopenhauer's motivational claim - which he in fact explicitly rejects - that "nothing can induce us to obey except fear of the evil consequences of disobedience" (BM 142) , he

would have to admit either that there are no morally motivated actions, or that he had characterized them incorrectly. The latter choice seemed obvious to Schopenhauer, who believed that few "are not convinced from their own experience that a man often acts justly, simply and solely that no wrong or injustice may be done to another," and that many of us help others with no intention in our hearts other than helping those whose distress we see (BM 1 38-39) . It is to such actions, he claims, that we attribute "real moral worth, " and they are motivated not by what Kant called "duty," but by compassion, "the immediate participation, independent of all ulterior considerations, primarily in the suffering of another, and thus in the prevention or elimination of it" (BM 144) . The "ulterior considerations" Schopenhauer regards as incompatible with compassion, and thus with moral worth, are egoistic concerns, concerns for one's own well-being. Schopenhauer agrees with Kant that if an action "has as its motive an egoistic aim, it cannot have any moral worth" (BM 1 41) . Unlike Kant, he does not infer from this that concern for another's happiness cannot give actions moral worth. From the premise that "egoism and the moral worth of an action absolutely exclude each other," he infers instead that "the moral significance of an action can only lie in its reference to others" (BM 1 42) . He draws this conclusion by way of the claim that the will is moved only by considerations of well-being or suffering. If moral worth does not belong to actions motivated by a concern for one's own well-being or suffering, it must belong to actions motivated by a concern for the well-being and suffering of others. How then would Schopenhauer answer Kant's implied question as to how concern for others' well-being can give an action moral worth when concern for one's own well-being does not? He could not claim that the sphere of other-regarding behavior simply is the sphere of morality, and thus that only other-regarding behavior is properly called "moral." Neither Schopenhauer nor Kant can regard the issue about moral worth that separates them to be simply a matter of what something is called. Both philosophers xvii I NTRO DUCTIO N assume that moral worth is a higher kind of worth - than, say, intellectual worth, aesthetic worth, or prudential value - and Kant describes moral worth as "that pre-eminent good which we call moral" (G 401 /69) . Schopenhauer claims not simply that we call acting for another's sake "moral," but that so acting has a higher value than acting for one's own sake. To answer Kant's question he must therefore show that there is a difference between these two kinds of motives that justifies the claim that one is of a higher value than the other. Though Schopenhauer never explicitly tries to answer this question, the kind of answer provided by his theory seems clear: it would be given in terms of his conception of the thing-in-itself. The distinction between appearances (the "phenomenal" or "sensible" world) and the thing-in-itself (the "noumenal" world) - that is, the distinction between the world as it appears to us and the world as it really is "in-itself" -

plays an important role in the moral theories of both Kant and Schopenhauer. In each case, the motive claimed to give moral worth to actions is also claimed to have its source in the noumenal world. For Kant, all inclinations and desires belong to the phenomenal world - they are the "appearances" in terms of which human actions, insofar as we encounter them in the "sensible world," the world accessible to sense observation, are explained and made intelligible. If human beings belonged solely to the world of appearances, all of their actions "would have to be taken as in complete conformity with the laws of nature governing desires and inclinations" (G 453/12 1) . Kant's claim that concern for the happiness of others "stands on the same footing as other inclinations" therefore means that it belongs to the world of appearances, that actions motivated by it are merely natural, that they are fully explicable in terms of our status as natural creatures, members of the phenomenal world. That this seems sufficient for Kant to dismiss it as a moral motive suggests that Schopenhauer was right to attribute to him the view he attributed to most philosophers: It is undeniably recognized by all nations, ages, and creeds, and even by all philosophers (with the exception of the materialists proper) , that the ethical significance of human conduct is metaphysical, in other words, that it reaches beyond this phenomenal existence and touches eternity. (BM 54) xviii

INTRODUCTION This is why Schopenhauer rejects Kant's view of moral worth: if recognizing that one ought to perform an action is always conditioned by fear of punishment or the desire for reward, acting from duty has no metaphysical significance, and therefore no moral worth. Kant would have to agree if he agreed about the role of reward and punishment in the recognition of duty - for he accepts the same principle: whatever belongs only to the phenomenal world cannot be the source of moral worth. That is why he rejects moral theories like Schopenhauer's that locate the source of moral worth in sympathetic concern for others: he regards such concern as rooted in natural inclination, and therefore as devoid of metaphysical significance. Acting out of reverence for the law, in contrast, does have metaphysical significance for Kant - for it involves recognizing as law the commands of the noumenal self. Although Kant denies that we can have knowledge of the thing-in-itself, he argues that we can make sense of morality only if we take human beings as they are "in-themselves" as autonomous, as legislators of universal law. To act morally is to act out of reverence for the law legislated by the noumenal self - the "true self," one is tempted to say. For Kant the noumenal source of the motive of duty bestows on actions an incomparably higher worth than could come from mere inclination (or anything else that belongs only to the phenomenal or natural world) . Schopenhauer had his own ideas regarding the thing-in-itself with which to counter Kant's suggestion that concern for others is of no more value than other inclinations. He believed that Kant had already shown that time and space do not belong to the thing-in-itself,

and therefore that individuality and plurality are foreign to the "true essence of the world" (BM 207) . Individuality is only the appearance in time and space of the thing-in-itself, which, in complete opposition to Kant, Schopenhauer took to be blindly striving will (the forerunner, perhaps, of Freud's id) . To the extent that we fail to recognize our individuality as mere appearance, we are moved to action only by egoistic concerns. We see the world completely in terms of how it affects our own wellbeing. If we care about the welfare of others, this is due not to our natural inclinations, but only to the recognition in others of something that lies beyond nature, of our "own self," our "own true inner nature" (BM 209) . Schopenhauer again stays within Kant's own terms: compassion, immediate concern for the welfare of another, possesses a higher worth than egoistic inclinations because, rather than being part of our natural equipment, it is a sign of our connection to a reality that goes beyond the phenomenal or natural world. This is basically the same claim Kant makes about the motive of duty. To have moral worth, Schopenhauer and Kant thus agree, actions must be motivated by something of higher value than egoistic concern, something that is rooted in a realm beyond the natural world. They disagree about moral worth because they hold very different views about which human motive is rooted in the noumenal world. From *Human, All Too Human* to *Daybreak In Human, All Too Human*, the work preceding *Daybreak*, Nietzsche began a long effort to free morality from the metaphysical world to which Kant and Schopenhauer had connected it. He set out to show that one need not posit the existence of such a world to explain the so-called "higher" activities - art, religion, and morality - which are often taken as signs of human participation in a higher or metaphysical realm (HA 10) . He wanted to explain these "higher" things in terms of the "lower," the merely human. The book's title, he writes in *Ecce Homo*, meant: " 'where you see ideal things, I see what is - human, alas, all-too-human!' - I know man better." In this book, Nietzsche continues, you discover a merciless spirit that knows all the hideouts where the ideal is at home . . . One error after another is coolly placed on ice; the ideal is not refuted - it freezes to death. - Here, for example, "the genius" freezes to death; at the next corner, "the saint"; under a huge icicle, "the hero"; in the end, "faith," so-called "conviction"; "pity" also cools down considerably - and almost everywhere "the thing in itself" freezes to death. (EH III: HA 1) The ideals Nietzsche places on ice are idealizations, beliefs that certain kinds of persons, activities, or states of mind exceed the standard of the merely human. "The saint" counts as an ideal because saints have been thought to represent "something that exceeded the human standard of goodness and wisdom" (HA 143) . Nietzsche places this ideal on ice by showing it to involve an error. He isolates the characteristics regarded as elevating saints above the human standard and explains them as expressions of egoistic drives to which no one would attribute an ideal

character. For instance, he explains their self-denial and asceticism in such terms as the lust for power and the desire to excite an exhausted nervous system (HA 1 35-42) . Applying the same method of "psychological observation" or "reflection on the human, all-too-human" (HA 35) throughout the book, Nietzsche explains many other idealized activities or types in terms of psychological needs that he considers egoistic and merely human. The ultimate effect of this procedure, he says, may be to lay an axe "to the root of the human 'metaphysical need'" (HA 37) . Even though "there might be a metaphysical world" (HA 9) , if we can explain the so-called higher aspects of human life without positing anything beyond the natural world, "the strongest interest in the purely theoretical problem of the 'thing in itself and the 'appearance' will cease" (HA 10) . If the human world can be explained without the assumption of a metaphysical world, the latter will be of no cognitive interest to us. We can say of it only that it is other than our world - an inaccessible, incomprehensible "being-other, . . . a thing with negative qualities" (HA 9) . In view of the importance of the noumenal world to the moral theories of Kant and Schopenhauer, we should expect Nietzsche's attack on ideals in *Human, All Too Human* to involve a rejection of both. Kant does not play much of a role, however, for, as the following passage suggests, Nietzsche had accepted his "great teacher" (CM: P) Schopenhauer's criticism of Kant's theory. For there is no longer any ought, for morality, insofar as it was an ought, has been just as much annihilated by our mode of thinking as has religion. Knowledge can allow as motives only pleasure and pain, utility and injury. (HA 34) Nietzsche presumably bases this denial of moral oughts on Schopenhauer's argument against Kant's categorical imperative - that a command or rule receives its force as an ought only from an egoistic concern with one's own pleasure or pain, advantage or injury. Schopenhauer's view entails that a belief in moral oughts depends on misunderstanding the way in which rules and commands affect behavior. If we realized that people feel obliged to obey them only because of egoistic concerns, we would not think of them as having a kind of moral force and thereby misinterpret them as moral oughts or categorical imperatives. Following out this line of argument and reflecting on the self-serving origins of I NTRO DUCTIO N just actions, Nietzsche writes (HA 92) : "How little moral would the world appear without forgetfulness!" Because *Human, All Too Human* attempts to exhibit the egoistic concerns lying behind our feelings of being obliged to do something, Nietzsche could expect it to undermine our sense that oughts have moral force and lead us to agree with Schopenhauer, that obedience to them can only be judged as either "wise or foolish," according to the circumstances. Schopenhauer had used this argument to support his own view of moral motivation and worth - that compassion, the one nonegoistic motive, rather than Kant's motive of duty, gives moral worth to actions. Nietzsche turns the same kind of argument against Schopenhauer in *Human, All Too Human*.

Compassion too can be explained in terms of what is egoistic, or human, all too human: For it conceals within itself at least two (perhaps many more) elements of personal pleasure, and is to that extent self-enjoyment: first as the pleasure of emotion, which is the kind represented by pity in tragedy, and then, when it eventuates in action, as the pleasure of gratification in the exercise of power. If, in addition to this, a suffering person is very close to us, we rid ourselves of our own suffering by performing an act of pity [or: through compassionate actions] . Apart from a few philosophers, human beings have always placed pity very low on the scale of moral feelings - and rightly so. (HA 103) . The opposition Nietzsche accepts between the moral and the egoistic should actually lead him to a more radical conclusion: that there are no moral actions. For he claims: No one has ever done anything that was solely for the sake of another and without a personal motive. How indeed could he do anything that was not related to himself, thus without an inner necessity (which simply must have its basis in a personal need)? How could the ego act without ego? (HA 1 33) Nietzsche's rhetorical question combined with his claim in the same passage that the whole idea of an "un egoistic action" vanishes upon "close examination," suggests that he considers the whole idea of an unegoistic action unintelligible. That

Nietzsche's 4 In the following passage, the German word *Mitleid* has been translated as "pity," following the normal practice among translators of Nietzsche, but this is the same word translators of Schopenhauer render as "compassion." xxii I NTRO DUCTIO N position is in any case a form of psychological egoism becomes even more obvious when he goes on to quote With approval Lichtenberg and La Rochefoucauld to the effect that we do not really love others - "neither father, nor mother, nor wife, nor child" - but only "the pleasant feelings they cause us" (HA 1 33) . We do not even love others, much less act solely for their sake. As we love only the satisfaction of our own interests, we always act for our own sake. If so, and if, as Nietzsche and Schopenhauer agree, actions cannot be both moral and egoistic, there are no moral actions. Recall that Schopenhauer views the moral significance of conduct as "metaphysical" in the sense that it "reaches beyond this phenomenal existence" and "directly touch [es] the thing-in-itself" (ww I: 422) . Because egoistic motives are fully comprehensible in terms of the phenomenal world, they have no moral worth. Unegoistic motives, in contrast, spring from "the immediate knowledge of the numerical identity of the inner nature of all living things" (ww II: 609) - an identity which is completely inaccessible to empirical knowledge and is therefore not to be found in the phenomenal world. Moral worth attaches to such motives precisely because they point beyond the phenomenal world to the thing-in-itself. Schopenhauer's assumption of the "numerical identity" of all living things is among the metaphysical assumptions

Nietzsche wanted to show we could dispense with in Human, All Too Human. This book began his task of "translat[ing] human beings back into nature" (BG 230) , and his first problem was to show that s

Part V

The Gay Science

1882/1887 — Translated by Adrian Del Caro / Josefine Nauckhoff

CAMBRIDGE TEXTS IN THE HISTORY OF PHILOSOPHY FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE The Gay Science CAMBRIDGE TEXTS IN THE HISTORY OF PHILOSOPHY Series editor KARL AMERIKS Professor of Philosophy at the University of Notre Dame DESMOND M. CLARKE Professor of Philosophy at University College Cork The main objective of Cambridge Texts in the History of Philosophy is to expand the range, variety and quality of texts in the history of philosophy which are available in English. The series includes texts by familiar names (such as Descartes and Kant) and also by less well-known authors. Wherever possible, texts are published in complete and unabridged form, and translations are specially commissioned for the series. Each volume contains a critical introduction together with a guide to further reading and any necessary glossaries and textual apparatus. The volumes are designed for student use at undergraduate and postgraduate level and will be of interest not only to students of philosophy, but also to a wider audience of readers in the history of science, the history of theology and the history of ideas. For a list of titles published in the series, please see end of book. FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE The Gay Science With a Prelude in German Rhymes and an Appendix of Songs EDITED BY BERNARD WILLIAMS All Souls College, Oxford TRANSLATED BY JOSEFINE NAUCKHOFF Wake Forest University POEMS TRANSLATED BY ADRIAN DEL CARO University of Colorado at Boulder CAMBRIDGE UNIVERSITY PRESS CAMBRIDGE UNIVERSITY PRESS Cambridge, New York, Melbourne, Madrid, Cape Town, Singapore, Sao Paulo, Delhi Cambridge University Press The Edinburgh Building, Cambridge CB2 8RU, UK Published in the United States of America by Cambridge University Press, New York www.cambridge.org Information on this title: www.cambridge.org/9780521636452 © Cambridge University Press 2001 This publication is in copyright. Subject to statutory exception and to the provisions of relevant collective licensing agreements, no reproduction of any part may take place without the written permission of Cambridge University Press. First published 2001 Seventh printing 2008 Printed in the United Kingdom at the University Press, Cambridge A catalogue record for this publication is available from the British Library Library of Congress cataloguing in publication data Nietzsche, Friedrich Wilhelm, 1844~1900. [Fröhliche Wissenschaft. English] The gay

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It is often designed to gather thoughts which will, so to speak, circle in on some central theme or problem. In his earlier works, Nietzsche had moved gradually towards this style. He had been appointed in 1869 as a professor of classical philology at the University of Basle, at the extraordinarily early age of twenty-four. He served in this position for ten years, resigning in 1879 because of the ill health which was to persist throughout his life. (The last letter he wrote, when in 1889 he broke down into insanity and a silence which lasted until his death in 1900, was to his distinguished colleague at Basle, Jacob Burckhardt, in which he said that he would rather have been a Swiss professor than God, but he had not dared to push egoism so far.) In his years at Basle he published first *The Birth of Tragedy*, which has the form, if not the content or the tone, of a treatise, and a set of four long essays collected as *Untimely Meditations*. In 1878-9 he brought out two books forming *Human, All Too Human*, followed in 1880 by a further part called 'The Wanderer and his Shadow', and in these writings he moved from continuous exposition and argument to setting out a sequence of thoughts which were not necessarily tied discursively to their neighbours, a style that allowed him to approach a question from many different directions. In *Daybreak*, which came out in 1881, the style is fully developed. As late as 25 January 1882 he still referred to what were to be the first books of *The Gay Science* as a continuation of *Daybreak*; by June they had acquired their separate title. When he made that decision, he sensed that Book Four, which is called "Sanctus Januarius" and invokes the spirit of the New Year, might be found obscure, and he was anxious about whether his correspondent, Peter Gast, would understand it. He knew that this was not just a set of penetrating, perhaps rather cynical, aperçus. 'Aphorism', the standard term which I have already mentioned, implies too strongly that each is supposed to be a squib, or a compact expression of a truth (often in the form of an exaggerated falsehood) in the style of the French writers La Rochefoucault and Chamfort, whom Nietzsche indeed admired, but whom he did not simply follow in giving a self-conscious exposé of some human failing, foible or piece of self-deception. There is a certain vill Introduction amount of that, particularly in the earlier books, but he was very aware of the risk that such aphorisms run of sliding from the daring through the knowing to the self-satisfied (it is not merely cynicism that he intends when he says in 379 that 'we are artists of contempt'). His ambitions are deeper; the effect is meant to be cumulative, and its aim is more systematically subversive. A philosopher who had a similar intention, though in totally different connections, is the later Wittgenstein, and Nietzsche might have called the sections of this book, as Wittgenstein called the paragraphs of his manuscripts, 'remarks'. His remarks cover very various subjects. Many of them touch on what may be called moral psychology, and sometimes he does claim to detect an egoistic origin of some ethically approved reaction (as he does, for example, in the shrewd observation

about magnanimity and revenge at section 49). The search for the ‘shameful origin’ of our moral sentiments was later to become an important principle of his genealogical method. But he is very clear that mere reductionism, the readily cynical explanation of all such attitudes in terms of self-interest, is a mistake. Partly this is because he does not think that self-interest is an individual’s basic motive anyway, and this book contains some quite complex, if unresolved, reflections on that question, in particular when he considers whether the virtues have a value for the individual who possesses them, or for the group. But, more broadly, Nietzsche thinks that the reductive spirit itself can be in error, a form of vulgarity (3), and that the ‘realists’ who congratulate themselves on having the measure of human unreason and self-deception are usually themselves in the grip of some ancient fantasy (57). Above all, it is simply not enough, in Nietzsche’s view, to ‘unmask’ some supposedly honourable sentiment or opinion and leave it at that. ‘Only as creators can we destroy’, he very significantly says (58). What things are called is fundamentally important, but a conventional set of names — as we may say, an interpretation — can be replaced only by another, more powerful, interpretation. When we say that one interpretation is more powerful than another, it is vitally important what counts as ‘power’. It is often said that Nietzsche explains everything in terms of power. This says something about the way in which he saw these problems, but it is wrong if it is supposed to state his solution to it. The point is very clear in *On the Genealogy of Morality*. There he tells a story of how a certain outlook or interpretation, embodying ix Introduction metaphysical illusions, came into existence as a psychological compensation for the weakness of people who were powerless, and how this outlook triumphed over the conventionally strong and their view of the world. The question must be, how could this have come about? What was the source of this new power? There had to be something to this new way of describing the world which accounted in naturalistic terms for its triumph, and Nietzsche fully accepts this, even if he does not have a very rich vocabulary of social explanation in which he can discuss what it might be. ‘Let us. . . not forget’, he goes on in section 58 of *The Gay Science*, ‘that in the long run it is enough to create new names and valuations and appearances of truth in order to create new “things”’. Indeed, but this immediately raises the question, one to which Nietzsche returned in many different connections: what must someone do to ‘create’ new names? The words ‘*The Gay Science*’ translate the German title ‘*Die Fröhliche Wissenschaft*’. No one, presumably, is going to be misled by the more recent associations of the word ‘gay’ — it simply means joyful, light-hearted, and above all, lacking in solemnity (section 327, on taking things seriously, says something about this). ‘Science’ has its own difficulties. The word ‘*Wissenschaft*’, unlike the English word ‘science’ in its modern use, does not mean simply the natural and biological sciences — they are, more specifically, ‘*Naturwissenschaft*’. It means any

organized study or body of knowledge, including history, philology, criticism and generally what we call ‘the humanities’, and that is often what Nietzsche has in mind when he uses the word in the text (it is often translated as ‘science’, for want of a brief alternative). But in the title itself there is an idea still broader than this. It translates a phrase, ‘gai saber’, or, as Nietzsche writes on his title page, ‘gaya scienza’, which referred to the art of song cultivated by the medieval troubadours of Provence, and with that, as he explains in *Beyond Good and Evil* (260), it invokes an aristocratic culture of courtly love. As he made clear, this association comes out in the fact that the book contains poems. But the title has other implications as well. One — particularly important to understanding this book and Nietzsche more generally — is that, just as the troubadours possessed not so much a body of information as an art, so Nietzsche’s ‘gay science’ does not in the first place consist of a doctrine, a theory or body of knowledge. While it involves and encourages hard and rigorous thought, and to this extent the standard xX Introduction implications of ‘Wissenschaft’ are in place, it is meant to convey a certain spirit, one that in relation to understanding and criticism could defy the ‘spirit of gravity’ as lightly as the troubadours, supposedly, celebrated their loves. This is why the original publisher could announce at the beginning of the book that it brought to a conclusion a series of Nietzsche’s writings (including *Human, All Too Human* and *Daybreak*) which shared the aim of setting out ‘a new image and ideal of the free spirit’. He said that it was the most personal of his books, meaning that in part it was explicitly about his own life: some of it is like a diary. It is not irrelevant that the ‘gai saber’ belonged to the south of Europe, to the Mediterranean. Nietzsche spent much of his time in the last years of his working life in Italy (in places such as those he praises in sections 281 and 291), and he was very conscious of the contrast between overcast German earnestness and Southern sun and freedom, an idea which had a long literary history and had been most famously expressed, perhaps, in Goethe’s *Italian Journey*. That is a recurrent contrast in *The Gay Science*, but, as so often with Nietzsche, it is not one contrast, and his reflections on the German spirit in philosophy and religion are specially nuanced in this book, for instance in his discussion (357) of ‘What is German?’ Nietzsche’s general reflections, here as elsewhere, have some recurrent weaknesses. There are cranky reflections on diet and climate. His opinions about women and sex, even if they include (as at 71) one or two shrewd and compassionate insights into the conventions of his time, are often shallow and sometimes embarrassing; they were, biographically, the product of an experience which had been drastically limited and disappointing. However, what is most significant for his thought as a whole is the fact that his resources for thinking about modern society and politics, in particular about the modern state, were very thin. The point is not that he was opposed to a free society, equal rights, and other typically modern aspirations

(though he certainly was, as section 377, for instance, makes clear). In fact, Nietzsche has by no means been a hero exclusively of the political Right, and many radical, socialist and even feminist groups in the last century found support in his writings.” 2 A very interesting study in this connection is Steven E. Ascheim, *The Nietzsche Legacy in Germany 1890~1990* (Berkeley: University of California Press, 1992). A helpful discussion of Nietzsche’s political thought is Bruce Detwiler, *Nietzsche and the Politics of Aristocratic Radicalism* xi

Introduction This was possible just because the deeply radical spirit of his work was combined with a lack of effective political and social ideas, leaving a blank on which many different aspirations could be projected. His clearly aristocratic sympathies are, in political connections, not so much reactionary as archaic, and while he has many illuminating things to say about the religious and cultural history of Europe, his conception of social relations owes more to his understanding of the ancient world than to a grasp of modernity. The idea of nihilism which is so important in his later works is undeniably relevant to modern conditions, but his discussions of such subjects as ‘corruption’ (in section 23 of this book) borrow a lot from the rhetoric of the Roman Empire and the disposition of its writers to praise the largely imaginary virtues of the vanished Republic. The *Gay Science* marks a decisive step beyond the books that came before it because it introduces two of what were to become Nietzsche’s best-known themes, the Death of God and the Eternal Recurrence. The idea that God is dead occurs first at 108, in association with the image of the Buddha’s shadow, still to be seen in a cave for centuries after his death. This is followed at 125 by the haunting story of a madman with a lantern in the bright morning, looking for God. He is met by ridicule, and he concludes that he has ‘come too early’, that the news of God’s death has not yet reached humanity, even though they have killed him themselves. This idea recurs in more literal terms in 343, the first section of Book Five (published, we may recall, five years later). The death of God is identified there as the fact that ‘the belief in . . . God has become unbelievable’: this, ‘the greatest recent event’, is beginning to cast its shadow across Europe. Once this event is fully recognized, it will have incalculable consequences, in particular for European morality. Some of these consequences will be melancholy, and indeed elsewhere Nietzsche struggles with the question of what act of creation, by whom, might overcome the emptiness left by the collapse of traditional illusions. But here the news brings, at least in the short term, only joy, a sense of daybreak and freedom, the promise of an open sea: ‘maybe > there has never been such an ““open sea””’. (University of Chicago Press, 1990). Mark Warren, in *Nietzsche and Political Thought* (Boston: MIT Press, 1988), well brings out the limitations of Nietzsche’s social ideas, but is over- optimistic in thinking that if his philosophy were true to itself, it would offer a basis for liberalism. xii Introduction Nietzsche continued to think that the

death of God would have vast and catastrophic consequences. But on the account that he himself gave of Christian belief and its origins (in this book and in *Beyond Good and Evil*, but above all in *On the Genealogy of Morality*), should he really have thought this? He believed that the faith in the Christian God, and more generally in a reassuring metaphysical structure of the world, was a projection of fear and resentment, representing a victory of the weak over the strong. That metaphysical belief has died; it has been destroyed, as Nietzsche often points out, by itself, by the belief in truthfulness — and we shall come back to that — which was itself part of the metaphysical faith. But how much difference should he expect its death to make? He shares with another nineteenth-century subverter, Marx (with whom he shares little else), the idea that religious belief is a consequence, an expression of social and psychological forces. If those forces remain, and the Christian expression of them collapses, then surely other expressions will take its place. If need secretes thought, and the need remains, then it will secrete new thoughts. Indeed, Nietzsche does think this: he thinks that liberalism, socialism, Utilitarianism and so on are just secularized expressions of those same forces. But he thinks that they are too manifestly close to the original, and that our growing understanding that the world has no metaphysical structure whatsoever must discredit them as well. The death of God is the death of those gods, too. He has a particular contempt for benign freethinkers who hope to keep all the ethical content of Christianity without its theology: George Eliot is the unlucky target when the point is spelled out very clearly in *The Twilight of the Idols* (the section called ‘Expeditions of an Untimely Man’). But that is not the most important point. Even if the content of our morality changes noticeably, as for instance attitudes towards sex have done in recent times, much more basic and structural elements of it, its humanitarianism and its professed belief in equal respect for everyone, are in Nietzsche’s view too bound up with the mechanisms that generated Christianity, and will inevitably go the same way that it has gone. It is too soon, surely, to say that he was wrong. For Nietzsche himself there was another dimension as well, one immediately connected with his own values. He saw the unravelling of Christianity as part of the phenomenon that he called European nihilism, the loss of any sense of depth or significance to life. The world Xill Introduction might conceivably avoid destruction and overt hatred by organizing a pleasantly undemanding and unreflective way of life, a dazed but adequately efficient consumerism. Nietzsche probably did not think that such a society could survive in the long run, but in any case he could not reconcile himself to such a prospect or regard it as anything but loathsome. Contempt was one of his readier emotions, and nothing elicited it more than what he sometimes calls ‘the last man’, the contented, unadventurous, philistine product of such a culture. This book, like all his others, makes it clear that any life worth living must involve

daring, individuality and creative bloody-mindedness. This is indeed expressed in the 'gaiety' of its title. Gaiety can encompass contentment, as it does on New Year's Day at the beginning of Book Four, but when that is so, it is a particular achievement and a piece of good luck. Gaiety is not itself contentment, and while it rejects solemnity and the spirit of gravity, it does so precisely because it is the only way of taking life seriously. Nietzsche has been thought by some people to have had a brutal and ruthless attitude to the world; sometimes, perhaps, he wished that he had. But in fact, one personal feature which, together with his illness and his loneliness, contributed to his outlook was a hyper-sensitivity to suffering. It was linked to a total refusal to forget, not only the existence of suffering, but the fact that suffering was necessary to everything that he and anyone else valued. 'All good things come from bad things' is one of his fundamental tenets: it signals his rejection of what he calls 'the fundamental belief of the metaphysicians, the belief in the opposition of values' (Beyond Good and Evil, 2). This is, for him, a principle of interpretation, but it presents itself in the first instance simply as a fact, which he thought no honest understanding of the world could evade. If a sense of the world's achievements and glories ~ art, self- understanding, nobility of character — cannot in common honesty be separated from the knowledge of the horrors that have been involved in bringing these things about, then there is a question that cannot, Nietzsche supposed, simply be ignored: whether it has all been worth it. Thinkers in the past have supposed that the question could be answered, and answered positively. Leibniz, with his famous doctrine that this is the best of all possible worlds, believed in a cosmic cost- benefit analysis which would vindicate God's mysterious management. Hegel had told a progressive metaphysical story of the historical XIV Introduction development of freedom and reason, which represented the horrors as all dialectically necessary to the eventual outcome, so that we could be sure that none of them was meaningless. Neither of these fantasies, Nietzsche reasonably thought, could be taken seriously in the late 19th century. Nor, he came to think, could one take altogether seriously someone who answered the same question, but in the negative. In his earlier years he had been very impressed, as Wagner was, by the philosophy of Schopenhauer, and his references to Schopenhauer in this book are mostly respectful (more so than those to Wagner), but he came to be very sceptical about Schopenhauer's so-called pessimism, which had been expressed in the judgement (for instance) that the world's 'non-existence would be preferable to its existence'. 'We take care not to say that the world is worth /ess', he says at 346: The whole attitude of man. . . as judge of the world who finally places existence itself on his scales and finds it too light — the monstrous stupidity of this attitude has finally dawned on us and we are sick of it. Nietzsche recognizes that his own Birth of Tragedy had been full of the Schopenhauerian spirit. Taken in that spirit, the question of 'the

value of life', he came to think, had no answer and was indeed not a question. Yet it did not simply go away, because there remained what seemed to Nietzsche, at least, to be a fact, that anyone who really understood and held in his mind the horrors of the world would be crushed or choked by them. That fact left, if not a question to be answered, at least a problem to be overcome. Nietzsche presents the problem, and his way of overcoming it, in the form of the thought-experiment of the Eternal Recurrence, which appears for the first time in *The Gay Science*.^{*} In the startling words of 341, what would you think if a demon told you that everything in life would recur over and over again eternally? How would you answer the question "Do you want this again and innumerable times again???" This question, Nietzsche says, 'would lie on your actions as the heaviest weight'. It tests your ability not to be overcome by the world's horror and meaninglessness.

3 The World as Will and Representation, trans. E. F. J. Payne (2 vols., New York: Dover, 1969), vol. 1, chapter 46, p. 576

4 The phrase 'eternal recurrence' occurs first at sec 285, but in a more limited connection, of recognizing that there is no perpetual peace, but only (as the pre-Socratic philosopher Heraclitus taught) a cycle of war and peace.

xv Introduction There is no belief which could 'justify the world': confronted with the question of its value, or rather with the replacement for that question, which is the prospect of being crushed by the consciousness of what the world is like, the only issue is (as Nietzsche also puts it) whether one can say 'yes' to it, and the test of that is whether seriously and in the fullest consciousness you could will that the course of everything should happen over and over again, including not just its pain and cruelty and humiliation, but also its triviality, emptiness and ugliness, the last man and everything that goes with him. This is an entirely hypothetical question, a thought-experiment. It is not a matter, as I read him, of Nietzsche's believing in a theory of eternal recurrence. The idea (which does not occur in *Beyond Good and Evil* or *The Genealogy of Morality*) appears in Zarathustra in a form similar to that of *The Gay Science*, and Nietzsche mentions its importance in *The Twilight of the Idols* and in *Ecce Homo* (the intellectual autobiography that he wrote on the verge of insanity). There are some places in which it is treated as a theoretical idea, but they are largely confined to his unpublished notes (his *Nachlass*), some of which, particularly from his last years, were published in *The Will to Power*, which is not a book by Nietzsche at all, but a selection from these notes tendentiously put together by his sister. But if the idea of the Eternal Recurrence is a thought-experiment, how can answering its question lie on our actions 'as the heaviest weight'? If it is a mere fantasy, then how can 'willing' the Eternal Recurrence cost one anything at all? It seems as simple as saying 'yes'. But one has to recall that in facing the question one is supposed to have a real and live consciousness of everything that has led to this moment, in particular to what we value. We would have to think in vivid detail, if we could, of every

dreadful happening that has been necessary to create Venice, or Newton's science, or whatever one thinks best of in our morality. Then we would have not simply to say 'yes', but to say 'yes' and mean it. That does not seem exactly weightless. What perhaps does less work in the thought-experiment is the element, which Nietzsche certainly thought essential to it, of eternity. If there is anything in this test at all, why would willing one recurrence not be enough? If you could overcome the 'nausea', as Zarathustra repeatedly puts it, of the prospect that the horrors and the last man and all the rest will come round again even once, and say 'yes' to it, you would have taken the XVI Introduction essential step: could willing all those further recurrences cost you very much more? There is another, very natural, reaction to the problem, which is almost everyone's reaction: to forget about it. One can forget that the horrors exist, and also, if one has a taste for metaphysical consolations, that God is dead. The narrator of Scott Fitzgerald's *The Great Gatsby* says of Tom and Daisy that they 'retreated back into their money and their vast carelessness, or whatever it was that held them together', and that is, roughly speaking, the remedy that the 'last man' finds for Nietzsche's problem. David Hume spoke of 'carelessness and inattention' as the only remedy for sceptical doubts; but that is not the same, because Hume thought that sceptical doubts were unreal. Nietzsche knew that the considerations we all forget were not unreal, and he held obstinately to an idea of truthfulness that would not allow us to falsify them. In this book, he calls on honesty and intellectual conscience at 319 and (as we shall see) at 344; at 284 he speaks of those who have to have an argument against the sceptic inside themselves — 'the great self-dissatisfied people'. In *The Anti-Christ* (50), at the very end of his active life, he wrote: Truth has had to be fought for every step of the way, almost everything else dear to our hearts, on which our love and our trust in life depend, has had to be sacrificed to it. Greatness of soul is needed for it, the service of truth is the hardest service. — For what does it mean to be honest in intellectual things? That one is stern towards one's heart, that one despises 'fine feelings', that one makes every Yes and No a question of conscience! The value of truthfulness embraces the need to find out the truth, to hold on to it, and to tell it — in particular, to oneself. But Nietzsche's own dedication to this value, he saw, immediately raised the question of what this value is. We have taken it for granted, he thinks, and we have seriously misunderstood it: as he says in *Beyond Good and Evil* (177), 'Perhaps nobody yet has been truthful enough about what "truthfulness" is.' Section 344 of *The Gay Science* (the second section of Book Five) gives one of Nietzsche's most important and illuminating statements of this question: This unconditional will to truth — what is it? Is it the will not to let oneself be deceived? Is it the will not to deceive? For the will to XVI Introduction truth could be interpreted in this second way, too — if 'I do not want to deceive myself' is included as a special

case under the generalization 'I do not want to deceive'. But why not deceive? But why not allow oneself to be deceived? The reasons for not wanting to be deceived, he goes on to say, are prudential; seen in that light, wanting to get things right in our intellectual studies and in practical life will be a matter of utility. But those considerations cannot possibly sustain an unconditional value for truth: much of the time it is more useful to believe falsehoods. Our belief in the unconditional will to truth must have originated in spite of the fact that the disutility and dangerousness of 'the will to truth' or 'truth at any price' is proved to it constantly. 'At any price': we understand this well enough once we have offered and slaughtered one faith after another on this altar! Consequently, 'will to truth' does not mean 'I do not want to let myself be deceived' but — there is no alternative — 'I will not deceive, not even myself'; and with that we stand on moral ground. . . . you will have gathered what I am getting at, namely, that it is still a metaphysical faith upon which our faith in science rests — that even we knowers of today, we godless anti-metaphysicians, still take our fire, too, from the flame lit by the thousand-year-old faith, the Christian faith which was also Plato's faith, that God is truth; that truth is divine. . . . The title of the section is 'In what way we, too, are still pious'. The idea is developed further in Book 111 of *On the Genealogy of Morality*, where the 'ascetic ideal' which has received an unflattering genealogical explanation is discovered to lie at the root of the will to truth, which powered the need to discover that very explanation. But that does not overthrow the will to truth: 'I have every respect for the ascetic ideal in so far as it is honest!' (111.26). The 'unconditional will to truth' does not mean that we want to believe any and every truth. It does mean that we want to understand who we are, to correct error, to avoid deceiving ourselves, to get beyond comfortable falsehood. The value of truthfulness, so understood, cannot lie just in its consequences, as Nietzsche repeatedly points out. Earlier in this book (121), he says that various beliefs may be necessary for our life, but that does not show them to be true: 'life is not an argument'. XVIIil Introduction Already in *Human, All Too Human* (517) he had noted: 'Fundamental Insight: There is no pre-established harmony between the furthering of truth and the well-being of humanity.' Again, in *Beyond Good and Evil* (11) he says that we must understand that there are some judgements which 'must be believed to be true, for the sake of preservation of creatures like ourselves, though they might, of course, be false judgements for all that'. Truth may be not just unhelpful, but destructive. In particular the truths of Nietzsche's own philosophy, which discredit the metaphysical world, can (as we have seen) destructively lead to nihilism if they come to be accepted. In the *Nachlass* (*The Will to Power* 5) there is a revealing note, which mentions the way in which the idea of truthfulness has turned against the morality which fostered it, and ends with the remark: This antagonism — not to esteem what we know, and not to be allowed any longer to esteem the lies we

should like to tell ourselves — results in a process of dissolution. In what ways are we ‘not allowed’ to esteem these lies? To some degree, Nietzsche thought that this was already in his time a historical or social necessity: that, at least among thoughtful people, these beliefs simply could not stand up much longer or have much life to them. It is a good question whether this was right, indeed whether it is right today — particularly when we recall the secularized, political, forms which are now taken, as Nietzsche supposed, by the same illusions. What is certainly true is that Nietzsche took it to be an ethical necessity, for himself and anyone he was disposed to respect, not to esteem these illusions. He did think that there were things which, even for honest and reflective people, could rightly compensate in some ways for the loss of the illusions; it is in this spirit that he remarks elsewhere in the *Nachlass* (The Will to Power 822) ‘We possess art lest we perish of the truth.’ He does not mean that we possess art in place of the truth; he means that we possess art so that we can possess the truth and not perish of it. There continue to be complex debates about what Nietzsche understood truth to be. Quite certainly, he did not think, in pragmatist spirit, that beliefs are true if they serve our interests or welfare: we have already seen some of his repeated denials of this idea. A more recently fashionable view of him is that he shared, perhaps founded, a kind of *xix* Introduction deconstructive scepticism to the effect that there is no such thing as truth, or that truth is what anyone thinks it is, or that it is a boring category that we can do without. This is also wrong, and more deeply so. As we have seen, Nietzsche did not think that the ideal of truthfulness went into retirement when its metaphysical origins were discovered, and he did not suppose, either, that truthfulness could be detached from a concern for the truth. Truthfulness as an ideal retains its power, and so far from truth being dispensable or malleable, his main question is how it can be made bearable. Repeatedly Nietzsche — the ‘old philologist’, as he called himself — reminds us that, quite apart from any question about philosophical interpretations, including his own, there are facts to be respected. In *The Anti-Christ* (59) he praises the ancient world for having invented ‘the incomparable art of reading well, the prerequisite for all systematic knowledge’, and with that ‘the sense for facts, the last-developed and most valuable of all the senses’. At the beginning of *On the Genealogy of Morality*, he tells us that ‘the English psychologists’ should not be dismissed as old, cold, boring frogs; rather, they are brave animals, who have been taught to sacrifice desirability to truth, every truth, even a plain, bitter, ugly, foul, unchristian, immoral truth. . . Because there are such truths — He keenly detects elements in our intellectual structures which we mistake for truths. In *The Gay Science* he stresses the importance of ‘a law of agreement’, which regulates people’s thoughts and provides intellectual security (76). He stresses the historical, indeed the continuing, importance of these conceptions, but he does not think that they are the truth, or that they are immune

to the discovery of truth. They are contrasted with the truth, and the question is, what will emerge from a battle between them and a growing awareness of the truth: as he asks at 110, ‘to what extent can truth stand to be incorporated?’ In his earliest writings about truth and error, Nietzsche sometimes spoke as though he could compare the entire structure of our thought to the ‘real’ nature of things and find our thought defective. It is as though the business of using concepts at all falsified a reality which in itself was — what? Formless, perhaps, or chaotic, or utterly unstructured. Later, he rightly rejected this picture, with its implication that we can somehow look round our the edge of our concepts at the world to which we are XX Introduction applying them and grasp it as entirely unaffected by any descriptions (including, we would be forced to admit, the descriptions ‘formless’, ‘chaotic’, and so on).^o There are passages in *The Gay Science* where it is unclear whether he is still attached to this picture. He discusses fictions, the practice of regarding things as equal or identical or mathematically structured when they are not so or only approximately so (110, 121). He is making the point, certainly, that mathematical representations which are offered by the sciences are in various ways idealizations, and this is entirely intelligible. There is greater ambiguity when he suggests that nothing is really ‘identical’ or ‘the same’. To take an example: the concept ‘snake’ allows us to classify various individual things as ‘the same animal’, and to recognize one individual thing as ‘the same snake’. It is trivially true that ‘snake’ is a human concept, a cultural product. But it is a much murkier proposition that its use somehow /falsifies reality — that ‘in itself? the world does not contain snakes, or indeed anything else you might mention. Nietzsche came to see that this idea of the world ‘in itself’ was precisely a relic of the kind of metaphysics that he wanted to overcome. As a remark in the *Nachlass* puts it (*The Will to Power* 567): ‘The antithesis of the apparent world and the true world is reduced to the antithesis “world” and “nothing”’. It is less than clear, and also well worth considering, how far the formulations of *The Gay Science* still commit him to the murky metaphysical picture. Some of the same problems affect another idea which appears in the book, and which was to be important in works he wrote after it, the idea of ‘a perspective’. Our interpretative outlook, our particular ‘take’ on the world, is modelled on the analogy of a literal, visual, perspective, and this analogy has two implications: that we understand that there can be alternative perspectives, and, importantly, that these will be alternative perspectives on the same reality. In later works, Nietzsche is often less than definite about what is involved in this second implication, but he is very clear about the first implication, and indeed urges us to combine perspectives, or move between them, which shows that we not only know that there are other perspectival views, but that we know what some of them are. In *The Gay Science*, he seems on the very edge of stepping into this problem. Section 299, for instance, suggests that

we can make use of different perspectives. But at 374, 5 This is well argued by Maudemarie Clark, *Nietzsche on Truth and Philosophy* (Cambridge University Press, 1991). XXi Introduction where he says ‘we cannot reject the possibility that it [the world] includes infinite interpretations’, the idea of the ‘alternatives’ seems to remain an entirely abstract possibility: ‘we cannot look around our corner’. The ‘Greeks were superficial — out of profundity’, he says in the Preface (and he repeated the remark later, in the epilogue to Nietzsche contra Wagner). But the Greeks in their time could straightforwardly display a delight in surfaces and appearances which was indeed profound. That is not possible for us, after so much history: any such attitude for us will be a different and more sophisticated thing, and it will represent an achievement. At the very end of the book, he returns to the gaiety of the gay science, and calls up the ideal of ‘a spirit that plays naively, i.e. not deliberately but from overflowing abundance and power, with everything that was hitherto called holy, good, untouchable, divine. . .’ This might seem even inhuman in comparison to conventional forms of seriousness, that is to say, solemnity, and in spite of all this, it is perhaps only with it that the great seriousness really emerges; that the real question mark is posed for the first time; that the destiny of the soul changes; the hand of the clock moves forward. . . Then he adds, at the end of that section, ‘. . .the tragedy begins’. But immediately there comes the last section of all, Epilogue, in which the spirits of his own book tell him to stop these gloomy noises, these ‘voices from the crypt, and marmot whistles’. ‘Nicht solche Töne!’ they cry in an echo of Schiller’s Ode to Joy, ‘Not such sounds!’ He says he will give them something else — the poems, presumably, with which he ends the book. But he does so with a final question, and it is a question which he wanted his readers to ask themselves not just at the end of this book, but throughout it and indeed throughout all his books — ‘Is that what you want?’ XXii 1844 1846 1848 1849 1850 1858 1864 1865 1866 1868 1869 1870 1872 Chronology Born in Récken, a small village in the Prussian province of Saxony, on 15 October. Birth of his sister Elisabeth. Birth of his brother Joseph. His father, a Lutheran minister, dies at age thirty-six of ‘soft- ening of the brain’. Brother dies; family moves to Naumburg to live with father’s mother and her sisters. Begins studies at Pforta, Germany’s most famous school for education in the classics. Graduates from Pforta with a thesis in Latin on the Greek poet Theognis; enters the University of Bonn as a theology student. Transfers from Bonn, following the classical philologist Friedrich Ritschl to Leipzig where he registers as a philology student; reads Schopenhauer’s *The World as Will and Representation*. Reads Friedrich Lange’s *History of Materialism*. Meets Richard Wagner. On Ritschl’s recommendation is appointed professor of classical philology at Basle at the age of twenty-four before completing his doctorate (which is then conferred without a dissertation); begins frequent visits to the Wagner residence at Tribschen.

Serves as a medical orderly in the Franco-Prussian war; contracts a serious illness and so serves only two months. Writes 'The Dionysiac World View'. Publishes his first book, *The Birth of Tragedy*; its dedicatory preface to Richard Wagner claims for art the role of 'the highest XXIII Chronology 1873 1874 1876 1878 1879 1880 1881 1882 1883 1884 1885 1886 1887 task and truly metaphysical activity of his life'; devastating reviews follow. Publishes 'David Strauss, the Confessor and the Writer', the first of his *Untimely Meditations*; begins taking books on natural science out of the Basle library, whereas he had previously confined himself largely to books on philological matters. Writes 'On Truth and Lying in a Non-Moral Sense'. Publishes two more *Meditations*, 'The Uses and Disadvantages of History for Life' and 'Schopenhauer as Educator'. Publishes the fourth *Meditation*, 'Richard Wagner in Bayreuth', which already bears subtle signs of his movement away from Wagner. Publishes *Human, All Too Human* (dedicated to the memory of Voltaire); it praises science over art as the high culture and thus marks a decisive turn away from Wagner. Terrible health problems force him to resign his chair at Basle (with a small pension); publishes 'Assorted Opinions and Maxims', the first part of vol. 11 of *Human, All Too Human*; begins living alone in Swiss and Italian boarding-houses. Publishes 'The Wanderer and His Shadow', which becomes the second part of vol. 11 of *Human, All Too Human*. Publishes *Daybreak*. Publishes *Idylls of Messina* (eight poems) in a monthly magazine; publishes *The Gay Science* (first edition); friendship with Paul Ree and Lou Andreas-Salomé ends badly, leaving Nietzsche devastated. Publishes the first two parts of *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*; learns of Wagner's death just after mailing part one to the publisher. Publishes the third part of *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*. Publishes the fourth part of *Zarathustra* for private circulation only. Publishes *Beyond Good and Evil*; writes prefaces for new releases of: *The Birth of Tragedy*, *Human, All Too Human* vols. 1, 1, and *Daybreak*. Publishes expanded edition of *The Gay Science* with a new preface, a fifth book, and an appendix of poems; publishes *Hymn to Life*, a musical work for chorus and orchestra; publishes *On the Genealogy of Morality*. XXIV Chronology 1888 Publishes *The Case of Wagner*, composes a collection of poems, *Dionysian Dithyrambs*, and four short books: *Twilight of Idols*, *The Antichrist*, *Ecce Homo*, and *Nietzsche contra Wagner*. 1889 Collapses physically and mentally in Turin on 3 January; writes a few lucid notes but never recovers sanity; is briefly institutionalized; spends remainder of his life as an invalid, living with his mother and then his sister, who also gains control of his literary estate. 1900 ©Dies in Weimar on 25 August. XxVv Further reading The standard biography of Nietzsche in English is R. J. Hollingdale, *Nietzsche: The Man and his Philosophy*, recently published in a revised and updated second edition (Cambridge University Press, 1999). Lesley Chamberlain's *Nietzsche in Turin: An Intimate Biography* (Picador, 1997) gives a vivid picture of his life in the

period during which he was at work on *The Gay Science*. There are two excellent general introductions to Nietzsche's philosophy, a short book by Michael Tanner, *Nietzsche* (Oxford University Press, 1995) and a slightly longer and more technical book by Henry Staten, *Nietzsche's Voice* (Cornell University Press, 1990). Readers interested in Nietzsche's epistemology and metaphysics should consult Maudemarie Clark's *Nietzsche on Truth and Philosophy* (Cambridge University Press, 1991), John T. Wilcox, *Truth and Value in Nietzsche: A Study of his Metaethics and Epistemology* (University of Michigan Press, 1974), and Ken Gemes, 'Nietzsche's Critique of Truth', *Philosophy and Phenomenological Research*, 52 (1992), 47-66. Those with an interest in Nietzsche's moral philosophy should consult Alexander Nehamas, *Nietzsche: Life as Literature* (Harvard University Press, 1987). There are two recent helpful discussions of Nietzsche's political and social thought: Bruce Detwiler, *Nietzsche and the Politics of Aristocratic Radicalism* (University of Chicago Press, 1990) and Mark Warren, *Nietzsche and Political Thought* (MIT Press, 1988). See also Peter Bergmann, *Nietzsche, 'the Last Unpolitical German'* (Indiana University Press, 1987). For an interesting discussion of some aspects of Nietzsche's legacy, see Steven E. Ascheim, *The Nietzsche Legacy in Germany 1890-1990* (University of California Press, 1992).

XXV Note on the text The text used for this translation is printed in the now standard edition of Nietzsche's works edited by Giorgio Colli and Mazzino Montinari (Berlin, de Gruyter, 1967-77). Their edition, and that of Peter Pitz (Munich, Goldmann, 1994), have been used in the preparation of the footnotes to this edition.

XXVII *The Gay Science* ('La gaya scienza') This house is my own and here I dwell, I've never aped nothing from no one and — laugh at each master, mark me well, who at himself has not poked fun. Over my front door. The title is a translation into German (in our edition, into English) of the Provengal subtitle. *Gaya scienza* (joyful, cheerful, or gay science') was a term used by the troubadours in the twelfth to fourteenth centuries to refer to the art of poetry. In *Ecce Homo* Nietzsche writes that he has used the term *gaya scienza* here to designate the specific unity of 'singer, knight, and free spirit' which was characteristic of early Provengal culture.

Preface to the second edition I This book might need more than one preface; and in the end there would still be room for doubting whether someone who has not experienced something similar could, by means of prefaces, be brought closer to the experiences of this book. It seems to be written in the language of the wind that brings a thaw: it contains high spirits, unrest, contradiction, and April weather, so that one is constantly reminded of winter's nearness as well as of the triumph over winter that is coming, must come, perhaps has already come. . . Gratitude flows forth incessantly, as if that which was most unexpected had just happened — the gratitude of a convalescent — for recovery was what was most unexpected. 'Gay Science': this signifies the

saturnalia! of a mind that has patiently resisted a terrible, long pressure — patiently, severely, coldly, without yielding, but also without hope — and is now all of a sudden attacked by hope, by hope for health, by the intoxication of recovery. Is it any wonder that in the process much that is unreasonable and foolish comes to light, much wanton tenderness, lavished even on problems that have a prickly hide, not made to be fondled and lured? This entire book is really nothing but an amusement after long privation and powerlessness, the jubilation of returning strength, of a reawakened faith in a tomorrow and a day after tomorrow, of a sudden sense and anticipation of a future, of impending adventures, of reopened seas, of goals that are permitted and believed in again. How many and what 1 Roman winter festival at which usual bonds of social order were thrown off, social roles were reversed, etc. The Gay Science sorts of things did not lie behind me then! This stretch of desert, exhaustion, loss of faith, icing-up in the midst of youth; this onset of dotage at the wrong time; this tyranny of pain surpassed still by the tyranny of a pride that refused the conclusions of pain — and conclusions are consolations; this radical seclusion as a self-defence against a pathologically clairvoyant contempt for humanity, this limitation in principle to what was bitter, harsh, painful to know, as prescribed by the nausea that had gradually developed from an incautious and excessively luxurious spiritual diet — one calls it romanticism — oh, who could re-experience all of this as I did? But if anyone could, he would surely pardon even more than a bit of foolishness, exuberance, ‘gay science’ — for example, the handful of songs that have been added to the book this time, songs in which a poet makes fun of all poets in a manner that is hard to forgive. Alas, it is not only the poets and their beautiful ‘lyrical sentiments’ on whom this resurrected author has to vent his malice: who knows what kind of victim he is looking for, what kind of monster will stimulate him to pardon it? Incipit tragoedia,? we read at the end of this suspiciously innocent book. Beware! Something utterly wicked and mischievous is being announced here: incipit parodia, no doubt. 2 But let us leave Mr. Nietzsche: what is it to us that Mr Nietzsche has got well again?. . .A psychologist knows few questions as attractive as that concerning the relation between health and philosophy; and should he himself become ill, he will bring all of his scientific curiosity into the illness. For assuming that one is a person, one necessarily also has the philosophy of that person; but here there is a considerable difference. In some, it is their weaknesses that philosophize; in others, their riches and strengths. The former need their philosophy, be it as a prop, a sedative, medicine, redemption, elevation, or self-alienation; for the latter, it is only a beautiful luxury, in the best case the voluptuousness of a triumphant gratitude that eventually has to inscribe itself in cosmic capital letters on the heaven of concepts. In the former, more common case, however, when it is distress that philosophizes, as in all sick thinkers — and perhaps sick thinkers

are in the majority in the history of 2the tragedy begins' 3 'the parody begins' 4 Preface to the second edition philosophy — what will become of the thought that is itself subjected to the pressure of illness? This is the question that concerns the psycholo- gist, and here an experiment is possible. Just like a traveller who resolves to wake up at a certain hour and then calmly gives himself up to sleep, so too we philosophers, should we become ill, temporarily surrender with body and soul to the illness — we shut our eyes to ourselves, as it were. And as the traveller knows that something is not asleep, something that will count the hours and wake him up, we, too, know that the decisive moment will find us awake, that something will then leap forward and catch the mind 7 the act, i.e. in its weakness or repentance or hardening or gloom, and whatever else the pathological states of the mind are called that on healthy days are opposed by the pride of the mind (for the old saying still holds: 'the proud mind, the peacock, and the horse are the three proudest animals on earth'). After such self-questioning, self-temptation, one acquires a subtler eye for all philoso- phizing to date; one is better than before at guessing the involuntary detours, alleyways, resting places, and sunning places of thought to which suffering thinkers are led and misled on account of their suffering; one now knows where the sick body and its needs uncon- sciously urge, push, and lure the mind — towards sun, stillness, mildness, patience, medicine, balm in some sense. Every philosophy that ranks peace above war, every ethic with a negative definition of happiness, every metaphysics and physics that knows some /inale, a final state of some sort, every predominantly aesthetic or religious craving for some Apart, Beyond, Outside, Above, permits the question whether it was not illness that inspired the philosopher. The unconscious disguise of physiological needs under the cloaks of the objective, ideal, purely spiritual goes frighteningly far — and I have asked myself often enough whether, on a grand scale, philosophy has been no more than an interpretation of the body and a misunderstanding of the body. Behind the highest value judgements that have hitherto guided the history of thought are concealed misunderstandings of the physical constitution — of individuals or classes or even whole races. All those bold lunacies of metaphysics, especially answers to the question about the value of existence, may always be considered first of all as symptoms of certain bodies; and if such world affirmations or world negations lack altogether any grain of significance when measured scientifically, they give the historian and psychologist all the more valuable hints as symptoms 5 The Gay Science of the body, of its success or failure, its fullness, power and high- handedness in history, or of its frustrations, fatigues, impoverishments, its premonitions of the end, its will to an end. I am still waiting for a philosophical physician in the exceptional sense of the term — someone who has set himself the task of pursuing the problem of the total health of a people, time, race or of humanity — to summon the courage at last to push my suspicion to its limit and

risk the proposition: what was at stake in all philosophizing hitherto was not at all ‘truth’ but rather something else — let us say health, future, growth, power, life. . . 3 — One might guess that I do not want to take my leave ungratefully from that time of severe illness whose profits I have not yet exhausted even today: I am well aware of the advantages that my erratic health gives me over all burly minds. A philosopher who has passed through many kinds of health, and keeps passing through them again and again, has passed through an equal number of philosophies; he simply cannot but translate his state every time into the most spiritual form and distance — this art of transfiguration just is philosophy. We philosophers are not free to separate soul from body as the common people do; we are even less free to separate soul from spirit. We are no thinking frogs, no objectifying and registering devices with frozen innards — we must constantly give birth to our thoughts out of our pain and maternally endow them with all that we have of blood, heart, fire, pleasure, passion, agony, conscience, fate, and disaster. Life — to us, that means constantly trans- forming all that we are into light and flame, and also all that wounds us; we simply can do no other. And as for illness: are we not almost tempted to ask whether we can do without it at all? Only great pain is the liberator of the spirit, as the teacher of the great suspicion that turns every U into an X,* a real, proper X, that is, the penultimate one before the final one. Only great pain, that long, slow pain that takes its time and in which we are burned, as it were, over green wood, forces us philosophers to descend into our ultimate depths and put aside all trust, everything good-natured, veiling, mild, average — things in which formerly we may have found our humanity. I doubt that such pain + ‘to make a U out to be an X’ is a standard German expression for trying to pretend that one thing is something completely different. Preface to the second edition makes us ‘better’ — but I know that it makes us deeper. Whether we learn to pit our pride, our scorn, our willpower against it, like the savage who, however badly tormented, repays his tormentor with the malice of his tongue; or whether we withdraw before pain into the Oriental Nothing- ness — called Nirvana — into mute, rigid, deaf self-surrender, self- forgetting, self-extinction: one emerges from such dangerous exercises in self-mastery as a different person, with a few more question marks, above all with the wi// henceforth to question further, more deeply, severely, harshly, evilly, and quietly than one had previously questioned. The trust in life is gone: life itself has become a problem. Yet one should not jump to the conclusion that this necessarily makes one sullen. Even love of life is still possible — only one loves differently. It is like the love for a woman who gives us doubts. . . But the attraction of everything problematic, the delight in an X, is so great in highly spiritual, spiritualized people such as these that this delight flares up like bright embers again and again over all the distress of what is problematic, over all the danger of uncertainty, and even over the jealousy of

the lover. We know a new happiness. . . 4 Finally, lest what is most important remain unsaid: from such abysses, from such severe illness, also from the illness of severe suspicion, one returns newborn, having shed one's skin, more ticklish and malicious, with a more delicate taste for joy, with a more tender tongue for all good things, with merrier senses, joyful with a more dangerous second innocence, more childlike, and at the same time a hundred times subtler than one had ever been before. How repulsive enjoyment is to us now, that crude, muggy, brown enjoyment as understood by those who enjoy it, our 'educated', our rich, and our rulers! How maliciously we nowa- days listen to the great fairground boom-boom with which the 'educated person' and urbanite today allows art, books and music — aided by spirituous beverages — to rape him for 'forms of spiritual enjoyment'! How the theatrical cry of passion now hurts our ears; that whole romantic uproar and tumult of the senses that is loved by the educated mob together with its aspirations towards the sublime, the elevated, the distorted, how foreign it has become to our taste! No, if we convales- cents still need art, it is another kind of art — a mocking, light, fleeting, The Gay Science divinely untroubled, divinely artificial art that, like a bright flame, blazes into an unclouded sky! Above all: an art for artists, only for artists! In addition we will know better what is first and foremost needed for that: cheerfulness — any cheerfulness, my friends! As artists, too, we will know this — I would like to prove it. There are some things we now know too well, we knowing ones: oh, how we nowadays learn as artists to forget well, to be good at not knowing! And as for our future, one will hardly find us again on the paths of those Egyptian youths' who make temples unsafe at night, embrace statues, and want by all means to unveil, uncover, and put into a bright light whatever is kept concealed for good reasons. No, we have grown sick of this bad taste, this will to truth, to 'truth at any price', this youthful madness in the love of truth: we are too experienced, too serious, too jovial, too burned, too deep for that. . . We no longer believe that truth remains truth when one pulls off the veil; we have lived too much to believe this. Today we consider it a matter of decency not to wish to see everything naked, to be present everywhere, to understand and 'know' everything. 'Is it true that God is everywhere?' a little girl asked her mother; 'I find that indecent!' — a hint for philosophers! One should have more respect for the bashfulness with which nature has hidden behind riddles and iridescent uncertain- ties. Perhaps truth is a woman who has grounds for not showing her grounds? Perhaps her name is — to speak Greek — Baubo?®. . . Oh, those Greeks! They knew how to live: what is needed for that is to stop bravely at the surface, the fold, the skin; to worship appearance, to believe in shapes, tones, words — in the whole Olympus of appearance! 5 Plutarch reports that in a temple in the Egyptian city of Sais, there was a veiled statue of the goddess Isis with the inscription: 'I am everything that is, that was, and that will be, and no

mortal has raised my veil.’ In his Critique of Judgement (1790, § 49) Kant says that this inscription is the ‘perhaps most sublime thing ever said’. In a short historical essay ‘Die Sendung Moses’ the German poet and dramatist Friedrich Schiller (1759-1805) speculates on a possible influence of this cult on Moses and thus on the origin of monotheism. Schiller also wrote a poem entitled ‘Das Verschleierte Bild zu Sais’ which told of an Egyptian youth who was especially eager to know The Truth. One night he broke into the temple and violated the prohibition by lifting the veil, but when found the next morning, he could not report what he had seen and died an ‘early death’. The Romantic poet Novalis (1772~—1801) gives two further variants (1798-9). In the first the youth left the young woman he loved, Rosenbliitchen, to go in search of wisdom, truth, etc. When he arrived at the temple he fell asleep and dreamed that when he lifted the veil of the statue ‘Rosenbliitchen sank into his arms’. In the second variant, when he lifted the veil, he saw himself. See also below, § 57. When the goddess Demeter was grieving for the abduction of her daughter by Hades, god of the underworld, the witch Baubo made her laugh again for the first time by lifting her skirts and exposing herself. an Preface to the second edition Those Greeks were superficial — out of profundity! And is not this precisely what we are coming back to, we daredevils of the spirit who have climbed the highest and most dangerous peak of current thought and looked around from up there, looked down from up there? Are we not just in this respect - Greeks? Worshippers of shapes, tones, words? And therefore — artists? Ruta near Genoa Autumn, 1886 ‘Joke, Cunning, and Revenge’ Prelude in German Rhymes Dare to taste my fare, dear diner! Come tomorrow it tastes finer and day after even good! If you still want more — I’ll make it, from past inspiration take it, turning food for thought to food. Since I grew weary of the search I taught myself to find instead. Since cross winds caused my ship to lurch I sail with all winds straight ahead. ‘Scherz, List, und Rache’ is the title of a libretto written by Goethe and set to music by Peter Gast, Nietzsche’s friend and disciple/secretary. The title itself, like the subtitle ‘Prelude in German Rhymes’, foreshadows the musical playfulness to be found both in the poems and in The Gay Science; it also voices the hope that readers will recognize in the German language a medium of grace and style, as seen for example in the writings of Goethe and Nietzsche. Scherz, List und Rache was not set to music in the 1780s, though Goethe had intended it for a composer, and he published it in 1790 with his other works. He had endeavoured in the 1780s, after his Italian journey, to reform the German comic opera in the direction of the Italian opera buffa. ii The Gay Science Where you stand, there dig deep! Below you lies the well! Let obscurantists wail and weep: ‘Below is always ~ hell!’ A. Was I ill? Have I recovered? Has my doctor been discovered? How have I forgotten all? B. Now I know you have recovered: Healthy is who can’t recall. Our virtues too should step lively to and fro: Like the verses of

Homer, they have to come and go! Stay not where the lowlands are! Climb not into the sky! The world looks best by far when viewed from halfway high. My way and language speak to you, you follow me, pursue me too? 'To thine own self and way be true: Thus follow me, but gently do! &. On the Third Shedding Already cracks and breaks my skin, my appetite unslaking is fuelled by earth I've taken in: 1 Vademecum is Latin for 'go with me', and refers to a book one carries all the time. Vadetecum is Nietzsche's improvement on the idea: 'go with yourself'. 12 'Joke, Cunning and Revenge': Prelude in German Rhymes This snake for earth is aching. Among the stones and grass I wear a path from fen to firth, to eat what's always been my fare you, my snake food, you my earth. Yes! My joy — it wants to gladden — , every joy wants so to gladden! Would you pluck my rose and sadden? You must crouch on narrow ledges, prop yourself on ropes and wedges, prick yourself on thorny hedges! For my joy ~— it loves to madden! For my joy — is malice laden! Would you pluck my rose and sadden? Much do I let fall and spiiil, thus I'm scornful, you malign. One who drinks from cups too full will often let much fall and spill — , yet never think to blame the wine. Sharp and mild, dull and keen, well known and strange, dirty and clean, where both the fool and wise are seen: All this am I, have ever been, — in me dove, snake and swine convene! If you want to spare your eyes and your mind, follow the sun from the shadows behind. 13 The Gay Science Slipp'ry ice is paradise as long as dancing will suffice. Better an enmity cut from one block than friendship held together by glue. Rust must be added: sharpness goes unsung! Else they will always say: 'He is too young!' 16. Upward 'How do I best get to the top of this hill?' 'Climb it, don't think it, and maybe you will.' Never beg! It's whining I dread! Take, I beg you, just take instead! It's narrow souls that I despise; not good, not evil, not my size. He shot an empty word into the blue to pass the time — and downed a woman too. A twofold pain is easier to bear than one pain: care to take a dare? 14 'Joke, Cunning and Revenge': Prelude in German Rhymes Don't let your ego swell too much, a bubble bursts with just a touch. 22, Man and Female 'Rob yourself the female, who to your heart appeals!' — So thinks a man; but she won't rob, a woman only steals. If I read me, then I read into me: I can't construe myself objectively. But he who climbs consuming his own might bears me with him unto the brighter light. You whine that nothing pleases you? Still pouting, friend, and must you mutter? I hear you curse, and shout and sputter — it breaks my heart and patience too! Come with me, friend! A nice fat toad, if swallowed voluntarily with eyes closed and summarily — might lessen your dyspeptic load. I know another person's thought and who I am, I know that not. My vision is too close to me — I am not what I saw and see. I'd use myself more perfectly if I could move away from me. Yet not so distant as my foe! My closest friend's too far off, no — 2 Nietzsche's inspiration for the toad as medicine derives from a maxim by Chamfort, to the effect that a toad

ingested each morning will make the rest of the day taste better. 15 The Gay Science give me instead the middle ground! Do you surmise what I propound? I must leave by a hundred stairs, I must ascend though I hear your cares: "You are hard: Are we made of stone?" I must leave by a hundred stairs, And being a stair appeals to none. 27. The Wanderer 'The path ends! Abyss and deathly silence loom!' You wanted this! Your will strayed to its doom! Now wanderer, stand! Be keen and cool as frost! Believe in danger now and you — are lost. See the child, with pigs she's lying, helpless, face as white as chalk! Crying only, only crying — will she ever learn to walk? Don't give up! Stop your sighing, soon she's dancing 'round the clock! Once her own two legs are trying, she'll stand on her head and mock. 2g. Stellar Egotism If I, round barrel that I am, did not roll 'round me like a cam, how could I bear, and not catch fire, to the chase the sun as I desire? The closest one from me I bar: Away and up with him, and far! How else could he become my star? 16 'Joke, Cunning and Revenge': Prelude in German Rhymes gu. The Disguised Saint Joy too great you are concealing, you engage in dev'lish dealing, devil's wit and devil's dress. But no use! Your eye's revealing piety and holiness! A. He stands and hears: what's wrong, he's thinking? What sound provokes his heart to sinking? What was it hurled him to the ground? B. Like all who once in chains were bound, He hears around him — iron clinking. Despised by me are following and leading. Commanding? Even worse to me than heeding! Who does not scare himself can frighten no one: The one who causes fear can lead another. But just to lead myself is too much bother! I love, as do the sea and forest creatures, to lose myself a while in nature's features, to hide away and brood in secret places until, lured home at last from distant traces, my self-seduction lets me see — my features. They write and write their desiccating learned la-di-da-di, as if primum scribere, deinde philosophant. Yes! At times I do make ice: Useful is ice for digesting! 3 Seneca (Roman philosopher) and his lot. The Latin: 'First write, then philosophize.' 17 The Gay Science If you had much for digesting, oh how you would love my ice! My old wisdom's A and O sounded here: what did I hear? Now it does not strike me so, just the tired Ah! and Oh! that youth inspired fills my ear. Into that region travellers must not go: And if you're smart, be cautious even so! They lure and love you till you're torn apart: They're halfwit zealots — : witless from the heart! God loves us because he created us! 'Man created God!' — respond the jaded. And yet should not love what he created? Should even deny it because he made it? Such cloven logic is limping and baited. Beneath the sweat of our own brow we have to eat our bread? If you sweat, eat nothing now, the wise physician said. The Dog Star winks: what does it know? What says its fiery winking? Beneath the sweat of our own brow our wine we should be drinking! * Alpha and Omega are the first and last letters of the Greek alphabet, hence proverbially the 'alpha and omega' are said to comprise everything. 5 Genesis 3:19: 'In the sweat of thy

face shalt thou eat bread.' 18 'Joke, Cunning and Revenge': Prelude in German Rhymes His gaze is envyleless: and him you praise? No thirst for your esteem perturbs his gaze; he has the eagle's vision for the long view, it's stars he sees, just stars — he looks beyond you! Happiness on earth, friends, only stems from war! Powder smoke, in fact, mends friendship even more! One in three all friends are: Brothers in distress, equals facing rivals, free men — facing death! Rather on your tiptoes stand than crawling on all fours! Rather through the keyhole scanned than gazed through open doors! It's fame on which your mind is set? Then heed what I say: Before too long prepare to let honor slip away. A scholar I? I've no such skill! — _ I'm merely grave — just heavy set! I fall and fall and fall until I to the bottom get. 6 Grindlich in German means thorough, based on Grund (ground). 19 The Gay Science 45. Forever "Today I come, I choose today' — think all who come and mean to stay. Though all the world may speculate: "You come too early! Come too late!" The sun is cursed by all men jaded; to them the worth of trees is ~ shaded! 47. Going Down' 'He sinks, he falls now' — thus resumes your mocking; in truth, look closely: Down to you he's walking! His super-joy became too much to bear, his super-light dispels your gloomy air. From now on time hangs by a hair around my neck, suspended there: from now on stars shine randomly, sun, rooster crow, and shadow flee, whatever brought time to my mind that now is mute and deaf and blind: — All nature's still in me, it balks at ticking laws and ticking clocks. Unknown to folks, yet useful to the crowd, I drift along my way, now sun, now cloud and always I'm above this crowd! ? Niedergang means decline, but it is ambiguous because it is formed from nieder (down) and the past participle of gehen (to go), Compare Zarathustra's 'going under' in the prologue of Thus Spoke Zarathustra. 20 'Joke, Cunning and Revenge': Prelude in German Rhymes Now she has wit — what led her to this find? Because of her a man had lost his mind. His head was rich before this misadventure: His head went straight to hell ~ no! no! to her! 51. Pious Wishes® 'Keys should all just disappear, lost from stem to stern, and in keyholes far and near skeletons should turn!' Thus thinks when the day is done each who is — a skeleton. I do not write with hand alone: My foot does writing of its own. Firm, free, and bold my feet engage in running over field and page. 53. 'Human, All Too Human.' A Book? When looking back you're sad and not robust, you trust the future when yourself you trust: Oh bird, do you belong to eagle's brood? Are you Minerva's favourite hoot hoot? Strong teeth and good digestion too — this I wish thee! And once my book's agreed with you, then surely you'll agree with me! 8 Dietrich in German is a skeleton key, or combination key capable of opening any lock. It is also a common given name for males. 9 Minerva, Roman goddess of wisdom, the arts and crafts, and medicine, was identified with the Greek goddess Athene, whose attribute was the sacred and wise owl. Vhu is the German word for eagle-owl, as well as the sound

(hooting) made by owls. 2 The Gay Science 55. The Realistic Painter “To all of nature true!’ - How does he plan? Would nature fit an image made by man? The smallest piece of world is infinite! — He ends up painting that which he sees fit. And what does he see fit? Paint what he can! Pl find wood, just give me substance strong enough to bind like glue! Cramming sense in rhyme is nonsense worthy of a boast — or two! Were it my choice to exercise, I know that I would opt for a cosy place in Paradise: Better still — outside the door! Your nose projects, so grand and plump, into the land, its nostrils pump — thus hornless rhino, lacking grace you fall, proud mortal, on your face! And that’s the way it always goes: Straight pride alongside crooked nose. My pen, it scribbles: this is hell! Have I been damned to have to scribble? — I dip it boldly in the well and write broad streams of inky drivel. See how it flows, so full, so pure! See how each thing I try succeeds! 10 Nashorn means rhinoceros, from Nase (nose) and Horn. 22 ‘Joke, Cunning and Revenge’: Prelude in German Rhymes The text’s not lucid, to be sure — So what? What I write no one reads. He climbs on high ~ him we should praise! But that one comes from high up always! Immune to praise he lives his days, he is the sun’s rays! Your life is halfway spent, the clock hand moves, your soul now quakes with fear! Long roaming forth it went and searched but nothing found — and wavers here? Your life is halfway spent: In pain and error how the hours did crawl!! Why can you not relent? — Just this I seek — some reason for it all! Yes! I know now whence I came! Unsatiated like a flame my glowing ember squanders me. Light to all on which I seize, ashen everything I leave: Flame am I most certainly! Ordained to move as planets do, what matters, star, the dark to your Roll blithely through our human time! Beyond its wretched mis’ry climb! The furthest world deserves your shine: For you compassion is a crime! One law applies to you: be thine! 23 Book One Book One I The teachers of the purpose of existence. — Whether I regard human beings with a good or with an evil eye, I always find them engaged in a single task, each and every one of them: to do what benefits the preservation of the human race. Not from a feeling of love for the race, but simply because within them nothing is older, stronger, more inexorable and invincible than this instinct — because this instinct constitutes the essence of our species and herd. One might quickly enough, with the usual myopia from five steps away, divide one’s neighbours into useful and harmful, good and evil; but on a large-scale assessment, upon further reflection on the whole, one grows suspicious of this tidying and separating and finally abandons it. Even the most harmful person may actually be the most useful when it comes to the preservation of the species; for he nurtures in himself or through his effects on others drives without which humanity would long since have become feeble or rotten. Hatred, delight in the misfortunes of others, the lust to rob and rule, and whatever else is called evil: all belong to the amazing economy of the preservation of the species, an economy

which is certainly costly, wasteful, and on the whole most foolish — but still proven to have preserved our race so far. I no longer know whether you, my dear fellow man and neighbour, are even capable of living in a way which is damaging to the species, i.e. ‘unreasonably’ and ‘badly’. What might have harmed the species may have become extinct many thousands of years ago and may by now belong to the things that are no longer possible even for God. Pursue your best or your worst desires, and above all, perish! In both cases you are probably still in some way a promoter and benefactor of humanity and are thus entitled to your eulogists — as well as to your mockers! But you will never find someone who could completely mock you, the individual, even in your best qualities, someone who could bring home to you as far as truth allows your boundless, fly- and frog-like wretchedness! To laugh at oneself as one would have to laugh in order to laugh from the whole truth — for that, not even the best have had enough sense of truth, and the most gifted have had far too little genius! Perhaps even laughter still has a future — when the proposition ‘The species is everything, an individual is always nothing’ has become part of humanity and this ultimate liberation and irresponsibility is accessible to everyone at all times. Perhaps laughter 27 The Gay Science will then have formed an alliance with wisdom; perhaps only ‘gay science’ will remain. At present, things are still quite different; at present, the comedy of existence has not yet ‘become conscious’ of itself; at present, we still live in the age of tragedy, in the age of moralities and religions. What is the meaning of the ever-new appearance of these founders of moralities and religions, of these instigators of fights about moral valuations, these teachers of pangs of conscience and religious wars? What is the meaning of these heroes on this stage? For these have been the heroes thus far; and everything else, even if at times it was all that we could see and was far too near, has always served only to set the stage for these heroes, whether as machinery and backdrop or in the role of confidant and servant. (The poets, for example, were always the servants of some kind of morality.) It is obvious that these tragedies, too, work in the interest of the species, even if they should believe that they are working in the interest of God, as God’s emissaries. They, too, promote the life of the species by promoting the faith in life. ‘Life is worth living’, each of them shouts, ‘there is something to life, there is something behind life, beneath it; beware!’ This drive, which rules the highest as well as the basest of human beings — the drive for the preservation of the species — erupts from time to time as reason and passion of mind; it is then surrounded by a resplendent retinue of reasons and tries with all its might to make us forget that fundamentally it is drive, instinct, stupidity, lack of reasons. Life ought to be loved, because ~! Man ought to advance himself and his neighbour, because —! What names all these Oughts and Because have been given and may yet be given in the future! The ethical teacher makes his appearance as the teacher of

the purpose of existence in order that what happens necessarily and always, by itself and without a purpose, shall henceforth seem to be done for a purpose and strike man as reason and an ultimate commandment; to this end he invents a second, different existence and takes by means of his new mechanics the old, ordinary existence off its old, ordinary hinges. To be sure, in no way does he want us to laugh at existence, or at ourselves — or at him; for him, an individual is always an individual, something first and last and tremendous; for him there are no species, sums, or zeroes. Foolish and fanciful as his inventions and valuations may be, badly as he may misjudge the course of nature and deny its conditions — and all ethical systems hitherto have been so foolish and contrary to nature that humanity would have perished from 28 Book One every one had it gained power over humanity ~— all the same! Every time ‘the hero’ appeared on stage, something new was attained: the gruesome counterpart of laughter, that profound shock that many individuals feel at the thought: ‘Yes, living is worth it! Yes, I am worthy of living!’ Life and I and you and all of us became interesting to ourselves once again for a while. There is no denying that in the long run each of these great teachers of a purpose was vanquished by laughter, reason and nature: the brief tragedy always changed and returned into the eternal comedy of existence, and the ‘waves of uncountable laughter’ — to cite Aeschylus! — must in the end also come crashing down on the greatest of these tragedians. Despite all this corrective laughter, human nature on the whole has surely been altered by the recurring emergence of such teachers of the purpose of existence — it has acquired one additional need, the need for the repeated appearance of such teachers and such teachings of a ‘purpose’. Man has gradually become a fantastic animal that must fulfil one condition of existence more than any other animal: man must from time to time believe he knows why he exists; his race cannot thrive without a periodic trust in life — without faith in the reason in life! And ever again the human race will from time to time decree: ‘There is something one is absolutely forbidden henceforth to laugh at.’ And the most cautious friend of man will add: ‘Not only laughter and gay wisdom but also the tragic, with all its sublime unreason, belongs to the means and necessities of the preservation of the species.’ And therefore! Therefore! Therefore! Oh, do you understand me, my brothers? Do you understand this new law of ebb and flood? We, too, have our time! 2 Intellectual conscience. — 1 keep having the same experience and keep resisting it anew each time; I do not want to believe it although I can grasp it as with my hands: the great majority lacks an intellectual conscience — indeed, it has often seemed to me as if someone requiring such a conscience would be as lonely in the most densely populated cities as he would be in the desert. Everyone looks at you with strange 1 A mistranslation of lines 89~90 of Prometheus Bound formerly ascribed to the fifth-century (BC) Athenian dramatist Aeschylus. The lines actually read: ‘countless laughter of the sea

waves'. 29 The Gay Science eyes and goes on handling their scales, calling this good and that evil; nobody as much as blushes when you notice that their weights are underweight — nor do they become indignant with you; perhaps they laugh at your doubts. I mean: to the great majority it is not contemptible to believe this or that and to live accordingly without first becoming aware of the final and most certain reasons pro and con, and without even troubling themselves about such reasons afterwards: the most gifted men and the noblest women still belong to this 'great majority'. But what are goodheartedness, refinement, and genius to me when the person possessing these virtues tolerates slack feelings in his believing and judging and when he does not consider the desire for certainty to be his inmost craving and deepest need — as that which separates the higher human beings from the lower! I discovered in certain pious people a hatred of reason and I was well disposed towards them for that: at least this betrayed their bad intellectual conscience! But to stand in the midst of this *rerum concordia discors*? and the whole marvellous uncertainty and ambiguity of existence without questioning, without trembling with the craving and rapture of questioning, without at least hating the person who questions, perhaps even being faintly amused by him — that is what I feel to be contemptible, and this is the feeling I look for first in anyone. Some folly keeps persuading me that every person has this feeling, simply as human. That is my type of injustice. 3 Noble and common. — For common natures all noble, magnanimous feelings appear to be inexpedient and therefore initially incredible: they give a wink when they hear of such things and seem to want to say, 'Surely there must be some advantage involved; one cannot see through every wall' — they are suspicious of the noble person, as if he were furtively seeking his advantage. If they become all too clearly convinced of the absence of selfish intentions and gains, they view the noble person as a kind of fool: they despise him in his pleasure and laugh at the sparkle in his eye. 'How could one enjoy being at a disadvantage? How could one want with open eyes to be disadvantaged? Some disease of reason must be linked to the noble affection' — thus they think and look 2 'the discordant harmony of things'; from Horace, *Epistles* 1.12.19 30 Book One disparagingly, the way they disparage the pleasure that a madman derives from his fixed idea. What distinguishes the common nature is that it unflinchingly keeps sight of its advantage, and that this thought of purpose and advantage is even stronger than its strongest drives; not to allow these drives to lead it astray to perform inexpedient acts — that is its wisdom and self-esteem. In comparison, the higher nature is more unreasonable — for the noble, magnanimous, and self-sacrificing person does in fact succumb to his drives; and in his best moments, his reason pauses. An animal that protects its young at the risk of its own life or during the mating period follows the female unto death does not think of danger and death; its reason likewise pauses because the pleasure in its brood or in the

female and the fear of being deprived of this pleasure dominate it totally; the animal becomes stupider than it usually is — just like the person who is noble and magnanimous. Such persons have several feelings of pleasure and displeasure so strong that they reduce the intellect to silence or to servitude: at that point their heart displaces their head, and one speaks thenceforth of ‘passion’. (Occasionally we also encounter the opposite, the ‘reversal of passion’, as it were; for example, somebody once laid his hand on Fontenelle’s heart and said, ‘What you have here, my dear sir, is also brains.’*) The unreason or odd reason (Unvernunft oder Quervernunft) of passion is what the common type despises in the noble, especially when this passion is directed at objects whose value seems quite fantastic and arbitrary. He is annoyed by the person who succumbs to the passion of the belly, but at least he comprehends the appeal that plays the tyrant in this case; but he cannot comprehend how anyone could, for example, risk health and honour for the sake of a passion for knowledge. The higher nature’s taste is for exceptions, for things that leave most people cold and seem to lack sweetness; the higher nature has a singular value standard. Moreover, it usually believes that the idiosyncrasy of its taste is not a singular value standard; rather, it posits its values and disvalues as generally valid and so becomes incomprehensible and impractical. It is very rare that a higher nature has enough reason left over to understand and treat commonplace people as what they are; above all, it believes in its own passion as something that is present in everyone but 3 French writer of fables (1657-1757); his most important work is the *Dialogues of the Dead* (1683) to which Nietzsche refers in § 94. 31 The Gay Science concealed, and in this belief it is full of ardour and eloquence. Now when such exceptional people do not themselves feel like exceptions, how can they ever understand the common natures and arrive at a proper estimate of the rule! — and so they, too, speak of the stupidity, inexpedience, and fancifulness of humanity, stunned that the world is taking such an insane course and that it will not commit itself to that which ‘is needful’. ~ This is the eternal injustice of the noble. 4 What preserves the species. - The strongest and most evil spirits have so far done the most to advance humanity: time and again they rekindled the dozing passions — every ordered society puts the passions to sleep — , time and again they reawakened the sense of comparison, of contradiction, of delight in what is new, daring, unattempted; they forced men to pit opinion against opinion, ideal model against ideal model. Mostly by force of arms, by toppling boundary stones, by violating pieties — but also by means of new religions and moralities! In every teacher and preacher of what is new we find the same ‘mischief’ that makes conquerors infamous, even if its expression is subtler and does not instantly set the muscles in motion and for just that reason does not make one as infamous! What is new, however, is under all circumstances evil, being that which wants to conquer, to overthrow the old boundary stones and pieties; and

only what is old is good! In every age the good men are those who bury the old thoughts deeply and make them bear fruit — the farmers of the spirit. But that land is eventually exhausted, and the ploughshare of evil must come time and again. Nowadays there is a thoroughly erroneous moral theory which is celebrated especially in England: it claims that judgements of ‘good’ and ‘evil’ sum up experiences of what is ‘expedient’ and ‘inexpedient’; that what is called good preserves the species while what is called evil harms it. In truth, however, the evil drives are just as expedient, species-preserving, and indispensable as the good ones — they just have a different function. 5 Unconditional duties. - All persons who feel that they need the strongest words and sounds, the most eloquent gestures and postures, in order to 32 Book One be effective at all — revolutionary politicians, socialists, preachers of repentance with or without Christianity, all of whom refuse to accept semi-successes: they all speak of ‘duties’, and indeed always of duties with an unconditional character — without such duties they would have no right to their great pathos; they know that quite well! So they reach for moral philosophies that preach some categorical imperative, or they ingest a goodly piece of religion, as Mazzini* did, for example. Because they want the unconditional confidence of others, they first need unconditional confidence in themselves on the basis of some ultimate, indisputable and inherently sublime commandment, and they want to feel like and pass themselves off as its servants and instruments. Here we have the most natural and usually very influential opponents of moral enlightenment and scepticism; but they are rare. On the other hand, a very comprehensive class of these opponents can be found wherever self-interest teaches submission while reputation and honour seem to prohibit it. Whoever feels his dignity violated by the thought of being the instrument of a prince or party or sect or even a financial power — say, as the descendant of an old, proud family — but still wants to or must be this instrument before himself and before the public, needs poignant principles that can be mouthed any time, principles of an unconditional ‘ought’ to which one may openly submit and be seen to have submitted without shame. All refined servility clings to the categorical imperative and is the mortal enemy of those who want to deprive duty of its unconditional character: that is what decency demands of them, and not only decency. 6 Loss of dignity. — Reflection has lost all its dignity of form: we have made a laughing-stock of the ceremony and solemn gestures of reflection, and couldn’t stand an old-style wise man. We think too fast, while on our way somewhere, while walking or in the midst of all sorts of business, even when thinking of the most serious things; we need little preparation, not even much silence: it is as if we carried around in our heads an unstoppable machine that keeps working even under the most unfavourable circumstances. Formerly, one could tell just by looking at a person 4 Tealian liberal (1805-72). 33 The Gay Science that he wanted to think — it was probably

a rare occurrence! — , that he now wanted to become wiser and was preparing himself for a thought: one would set one's face as for prayer and stop walking; yes, one stood still for hours on the street once the thought 'arrived' — on one or two legs. The dignity of the matter required it! 7 Something for the industrious. - Anyone who now wishes to make a study of moral matters opens up for himself an immense field of work. All kinds of passions have to be thought through separately, pursued separately through ages, peoples, great and small individuals; their entire reason and all their evaluations and modes of illuminating things must be revealed! So far, all that has given colour to existence still lacks a history: where could you find a history of love, of avarice, of envy, of conscience, of piety, of cruelty? Even a comparative history of law or even of punishment is so far lacking entirely. Has anyone done research on the different ways of dividing up the day or of the consequences of a regular schedule of work, festivals, and the rest? Do we know the moral effects of foods? Is there a philosophy of nutrition? (The incessantly erupting clamour for and against vegetarianism proves that there is still no such philosophy!) Has anyone collected people's experiences of living together — in monasteries, for example? Has anyone depicted the dialectic of marriage and friendship? The customs of scholars, businessmen, artists, artisans — have they found their thinkers? There is so much in them to think about! Everything that humans have viewed until now as the 'conditions of their existence' and all the reason, passion, and superstition that such a view involves — has this been researched exhaustively? To observe how differently the human drives have grown and still could grow depending on the moral climate — that alone involves too much work for even the most industrious; it would require whole generations, and generations of scholars who would collaborate systematically, to exhaust the points of view and the material. The same applies to the demonstration of the reasons for the variety of moral climates ('why does the sun of one fundamental moral judgement and primary value-standard shine here — and another one there?'). Yet another new project would be to determine the erroneousness of all these reasons and the whole essence of moral judgements to date. If all 34 Book One these jobs were done, the most delicate question of all would emerge in the foreground: whether science is able to furnish goals of action after having proved that it can take such goals away and annihilate them; and then an experimenting would be in order, in which every kind of heroism could find satisfaction — an experimenting that might last for centuries and eclipse all the great projects and sacrifices of history to date. So far, science has not yet built its cyclops-buildings;> but the time for that will come, too. 8 Unconscious virtues. — All qualities of a person of which he is conscious — and especially those he supposes to be visible and plain to others also — are subject to laws of development entirely different from those qualities which are unknown or badly known to him, which conceal themselves

by means of their subtlety even from the eye of a rather subtle observer and which know how to hide as if behind nothing at all. This might be compared to the subtle sculptures on the scales of reptiles: it would be a mistake to take them for ornaments or weapons, since one sees them only with a microscope, i.e. with an artificially sharpened eye, which similar animals for whom they might signify something like ornaments or weapons simply lack. Our visible moral qualities, and especially those that we believe to be visible, take their course; and the invisible ones, which have the same names but are neither ornaments nor weapons with regard to others, also take their course: probably a totally different one, with lines and subtleties and sculptures that might amuse a god with a divine microscope. For example, we have our diligence, our ambition, our acuteness — all the world knows about them — and in addition, we probably also have our industry, our ambition, our acute-ness; but for these reptile scales, no microscope has yet been invented! At this point the friends of instinctive morality will say: ‘Bravo! At least he considers unconscious virtues to be possible — and that’s enough for us.’ Oh, how little you are satisfied with! 5 The Cyclopes, in ancient mythology, were one-eyed giants. Though represented in Homer as wild creatures, they elsewhere appear as workmen of superhuman power, and were credited with building massive ancient fortifications such as those of Tiryns. 35 The Gay Science 9 Our eruptions. ~ Countless things that humanity acquired in earlier stages, but so feebly and embryonically that no one could tell that they had been acquired, suddenly emerge into the light much later, perhaps after centuries; meanwhile they have become strong and ripe. Some ages seem to lack completely some talent or virtue, just as some people do: but just wait for their children and grandchildren, if you have time to wait — they bring to light the inner qualities of their grandfathers, the qualities that their grandfathers themselves did not know about. Often it is already the son that betrays his father: the father understands himself better once he has a son. All of us harbour in ourselves hidden gardens and plantations; and, to use another metaphor, we are all growing volcanoes approaching their hour of eruption; how near or distant that is, of course, nobody knows, not even the good Lord. 10 A kind of atavism. —1 prefer to understand the rare human beings of an age as suddenly appearing, late ghosts of past cultures and their powers: as atavisms of a people and its mores — that way one can really understand something about them! They now seem strange, rare, extraordinary; and whoever feels these powers in himself must nurse, defend, honor, and cultivate them against another world that resists them: and so he becomes either a great human being or a mad and eccentric one, unless he perishes too soon. Formerly, these same qualities were common and therefore considered ordinary: they weren’t distinguishing. They were perhaps demanded, presupposed; it was impossible to become great through them, if only because there was also no danger of becoming mad and lonely through them. It is

principally in the generations and castes that conserve a people that we find such recrudescences of old instincts, while such atavism is highly improbable where races, habits, and valuations change too rapidly. For tempo is as significant a power in the development of peoples as in music: in our case, what is absolutely necessary is an andante of development, as the tempo of a passionate and slow spirit — and that is after all what the spirit of conservative generations is like. 36

Book One II Consciousness (Bewußtsein)[®] — Consciousness (Bewußtheit) is the latest development of the organic, and hence also its most unfinished and unrobust feature. Consciousness gives rise to countless mistakes that lead an animal or human being to perish sooner than necessary, ‘beyond destiny’, as Homer puts it.’ If the preserving alliance of the instincts were not so much more powerful, if it did not serve on the whole as a regulator, humanity would have to perish with open eyes of its misjudging and its fantasizing, of its lack of thoroughness and its incredulity — in short, of its consciousness; or rather, without the instincts, humanity would long have ceased to exist! Before a function is fully developed and mature, it constitutes a danger to the organism; it is a good thing for it to be properly tyrannized in the meantime! Thus, consciousness is properly tyrannized — and not least by one’s pride in it! One thinks it constitutes the kernel of man, what is abiding, eternal, ultimate, most original in him! One takes consciousness to be a given determinate magnitude! One denies its growth and intermittences! Sees it as ‘the unity of the organism’! This ridiculous overestimation and misapprehension of consciousness has the very useful consequence that an all-too-rapid development of consciousness was prevented. Since they thought they already possessed it, human beings did not take much trouble to acquire it - and things are no different today! The task of assimilating knowledge and making it instinctive is still quite new; it is only beginning to dawn on the human eye and is yet barely discernible — it is a task seen only by those who have understood that so far we have incorporated only our errors and that all of our consciousness refers to errors! 12 On the aim of science. - What? The final aim of science should be to give man as much pleasure and as little displeasure as possible? But what if 6 The usual German word for ‘consciousness’ is Bewußtsein (literally ‘being-in-a-state-of-awareness-of’) and this is the term Nietzsche uses in the title of this paragraph. He then however shifts to the much more unusual word Bewußtheit, which has an ending (eit) that usually signifies an abstract property, and argues against the view that having such a property is something fundamental or especially important to humans. 7 See Iliad 11.155 and xX.30, 336. 37 The Gay Science pleasure and displeasure are so intertwined that whoever wants as much as possible of one must also have as much as possible of the other — that whoever wants to learn to ‘jubilate up to the heavens’ must also be prepared for ‘grief unto death’?[®] And that may well be the way things are! At least the Stoics believed that this is how

things are, and they were consistent when they also desired as little pleasure as possible in order to derive as little pain as possible from life (by using the saying ‘The virtuous man is the happiest man’, they had both a school slogan for the masses and a fine casuistic delicacy for the refined). Even today you still have the choice: either as little displeasure as possible, in short, lack of pain ~and socialists and politicians of all parties fundamentally have no right to promise their people any more than that — or as much displeasure as possible as the price for the growth of a bounty of refined pleasures and joys that hitherto have seldom been tasted. Should you decide on the former, i.e. if you want to decrease and diminish people’s susceptibility to pain, you also have to decrease and diminish their capacity for joy. With science one can actually promote either of these goals! So far it may still be better known for its power to deprive man of his joys and make him colder, more statue-like, more stoic. But it might yet be found to be the great giver of pain! — And then its counterforce might at the same time be found: its immense capacity for letting new galaxies of joy flare up! 13 On the doctrine of the feeling of power. — Benefiting and hurting others are ways of exercising one’s power over them — that is all one wants in such cases! We hurt those to whom we need to make our power perceptible, for pain is a much more sensitive means to that end than pleasure: pain always asks for the cause, while pleasure is inclined to stop with itself and not look back. We benefit and show benevolence toward those who already depend on us in some way (that is, who are used to thinking of us as their causes); we want to increase their power because we thus increase our own, or we want to show them the advantage of being in our power ~ that way, they will be more satisfied with their situation and 8 Quotation from Act 111, Scene 2 of Goethe’s *Egmont*, frequently cited in Germany as an archetypal description of the Romantic personality. 9 This doctrine, originally defended by Socrates (see Xenophon, *Memorabilia* 111.5), was a central part of Stoic ethics (see A. A. Long and D. Sedley, *The Hellenistic Philosophers* [Cambridge University Press, 1987], esp. vol. 1, pp. 344~—436, and esp. pp. 357—9). 38 Book One more hostile towards and willing to fight against the enemies of our power. Whether in benefiting or hurting others we make sacrifices does not affect the ultimate value of our actions; even if we stake our lives, as martyrs do for their church, it is a sacrifice made for our desire for power or for the preservation of our feeling of power. He who feels ‘I am in possession of the truth’ —~ how many possessions does he not renounce in order to save this feeling! What would he not throw overboard in order to stay ‘on top’ — that is, above the others who lack ‘the truth’! The state in which we hurt others is certainly seldom as agreeable, in an unadulterated way, as that in which we benefit others; it is a sign that we are still lacking power, or it betrays a frustration in the face of this poverty; it brings new dangers and uncertainties to the power we do possess and clouds our horizon with the

prospect of revenge, scorn, punishment, failure. Only to the most irritable and covetous adherents of the feeling of power — to those for whom the sight of those who are already subjected (the objects of benevolence) is a burden and boredom — might it be more pleasurable to imprint the seal of power on the reluctant. It depends on how one is accustomed to spice one's life; it is a matter of taste whether one prefers the slow or the sudden, the safe or the dangerous and daring increase in power — one always seeks this or that spice according to one's temperament. An easy prey is something contemptible for proud natures; they take delight only at the sight of unbroken persons who could become their enemies and at the sight of all possessions that are hard to come by; they are often hard towards someone who is suffering, for he is not worthy of their contention and pride — but they are the more obliging toward their equals, against whom it would be honourable to fight and struggle if the occasion should arise. Spurred by the good feeling of this perspective, the members of the knightly caste became accustomed to treating each others with exquisite courtesy. Compassion is the most agreeable feeling for those who have little pride and no prospect of great conquests; for them, easy prey — and that is what those who suffer are — is something enchanting. Compassion is praised as the virtue of prostitutes. 14 The things people call love. - Greed and love: such different feelings these terms evoke! And yet it could be the same instinct, named twice: 39 The Gay Science once disparaged by those who already have, in whom the instinct has somewhat calmed down and who now fear for what they 'have'; the other time seen from the standpoint of the unsatisfied, the thirsty, and therefore glorified as 'good'. Our love of our neighbours — is it not a craving for new property? And likewise our love of knowledge, of truth, and altogether any craving for what is new? We slowly grow tired of the old, of what we safely possess, and we stretch out our hands again; even the most beautiful landscape is no longer sure of our love after we have lived in it for three months, and some more distant coast excites our greed: possession usually diminishes the possession. The pleasure we take in ourselves tries to preserve itself by time and again changing something new into ourselves — that is simply what possession means. To grow tired of a possession is to grow tired of ourselves. (One can also suffer from an excess — even the desire to throw away, to dole out, can take on the honorary name 'love'.) When we see someone suffering, we like to use this opportunity to take possession of him; that is for example what those who become his benefactors and those who have compassion for him do, and they call the lust for new possessions that is awakened in them 'love'; and their delight is like that aroused by the prospect of a new conquest. Sexual love, however, is what most clearly reveals itself as a craving for new property: the lover wants unconditional and sole possession of the longed-for person; he wants a power over her soul as unconditional as his power over her body; he wants to be the

only beloved, to live and to rule in the other soul as that which is supreme and most desirable. If one considers that this means excluding the whole world from a precious good, from joy and enjoyment; if one considers that the lover aims at the impoverishment and deprivation of all the competitors and would like to become the dragon guarding his golden hoard as the most inconsiderate and selfish of all ‘conquerors’ and exploiters; if one considers, finally, that to the lover himself the rest of the world appears indifferent, pale, and worthless and that he is prepared to make any sacrifice, upset any order, subordinate any other interest; then one is indeed amazed that this wild greed and injustice of sexual love has been as glorified and deified as it has in all ages — yes, that this love has furnished the concept of love as the opposite of egoism when it may in fact be the most candid expression of egoism. Here is it evidently the have-nots and the yearning ones who have formed linguistic usage — there have probably always been too many of them. 40 Book One Those who were granted much possession and satiety in this area must occasionally have made some casual remark about ‘the raging demon’, as did that most charming and beloved of all Athenians, Sophocles!^o but Eros always laughed at such blasphemers; they were always precisely his greatest darlings. Here and there on earth there is probably a kind of continuation of love in which this greedy desire of two people for each other gives way to a new desire and greed, a shared higher thirst for an ideal above them. But who knows such love? Who has experienced it? Its true name is friendship. 15 From a distance. — This mountain makes the entire region it dominates attractive and significant in every way; having said this to ourselves for the hundredth time, we are so unreasonably and thankfully disposed toward it that we suppose that it, the bestower of such delight, must itself be the most delightful thing in the region — and so we climb it and are disappointed. Suddenly the mountain itself and the entire landscape around us, beneath us, seem to have lost their magic; we had forgotten that certain types of greatness, like certain types of goodness, want to be beheld only from a distance and always from below, not from above — only thus do they have an effect. Perhaps you know people near you who ought to view themselves only from a distance in order to find themselves at all tolerable or attractive and invigorating; self-knowledge is something they should be advised against. 16 Over the footbridge. - When dealing with people who are bashful about their feelings, one has to be able to dissimulate; they feel a sudden hatred towards anyone who catches them in a tender or enthusiastic or elevated feeling, as if he had seen their secrets. If one wants to do them good in such moments, one should make them laugh or utter some cold, jocular sarcasm: then their feeling freezes and they regain power over themselves. But I am giving the moral before the story. There was a time in our lives when we were so close that nothing seemed to obstruct 10 See Plato, Republic 329c. 41 The Gay Science our friendship and brotherhood, and only a

small footbridge separated us, Just as you were about to step on it, I asked you: ‘Do you want to cross the footbridge to me?’ — But then you didn’t want to any more; and when I asked again, you were silent. Since then, mountains and torrential rivers, and everything which separates and alienates, have been cast between us, and even if we wanted to reach each other, we couldn’t anymore! But when you think of that little footbridge now, you have no words anymore — only sobs and bewilderment. 17 Finding a motive for one’s poverty. — There is clearly no trick that enables us to turn a poor virtue into a rich and overflowing one, but we can surely reinterpret its poverty nicely into a necessity, so that its sight no longer offends us and we no longer make reproachful faces at fate on its account. That is what the wise gardener does when he places the poor little stream in his garden in the arms of a nymph and thus finds a motive for its poverty: and who wouldn’t need nymphs as he does? 18 Ancient pride. — The specific hue which nobility had in the ancient world is absent in ours because the ancient slave is absent from our sensibility. A Greek of noble descent found such immense intermediate stages and such a distance between his own height and that ultimate baseness that he could barely see the slave clearly any more: not even Plato could really see him. It is different with us, accustomed as we are to the doctrine of human equality, if not also to equality itself. A creature who is not at its own disposal and who lacks leisure is by no means something despicable to us on that account; perhaps each of us possesses too much of such slavishness in accordance with the conditions of our social order and activity, which are utterly different from those of the ancients. The Greek philosopher went through life feeling secretly that there were far more slaves than one might think — namely, that everyone who was not a philosopher was a slave; his pride overflowed when he considered that even the mightiest men on earth might be his slaves. This pride, too, is 41 Stoic doctrine; see e.g. Diogenes Laertius 7.121-2 (in Long and Sedley, *Philosophers*, vol. 1 p. 431) and Cicero, *De stoicorum paradoxis*, Paradoxon V. 42 Book One foreign and impossible for us; not even metaphorically does the word ‘slave’ possess for us its full force. 19 Evil. ~ Examine the lives of the best and the most fruitful people and peoples and ask yourselves whether a tree which is supposed to grow to a proud height could do without bad weather and storms: whether misfortune and external resistance, whether any kinds of hatred, jealousy, stubbornness, mistrust, hardness, greed, and violence do not belong to the favourable conditions without which any great growth even of virtue is scarcely possible? The poison from which the weaker nature perishes strengthens the strong man — and he does not call it poison. 20 The dignity of foolishness. — A few millennia further along the course set by the last century — and everything men do will display the highest prudence: but just that way prudence will lose all its dignity. Then it will, to be sure, be necessary to be prudent, but it will also be so commonplace and vulgar that even a moderately

aristocratic taste will experience this necessity as a vulgarity. And just as a tyranny of truth and science could increase esteem for the lie, a tyranny of prudence could spur a new kind of nobility. To be noble might then come to mean: to entertain follies. aI To the teachers of selflessness. – A person's virtues are called good with respect to their presumed effects not on him but on us and society — the praise of virtues has always been far from 'selfless', far from 'unegoistic'! For otherwise one would have had to recognize that the virtues (such as diligence, obedience, chastity, piety, justice) are mostly harmful to their possessors, being drives which dominate them all too violently and covetously and in no way let reason keep them in balance with the other drives. When you have a virtue — a real, complete virtue (and not just a small drive towards some virtue) — you are its victim! But the neighbour praises your virtue precisely on that account! One praises the diligent 43 The Gay Science even if he should harm his vision or the originality and freshness of his spirit, one honours and feels sorry for the youth who has 'worked himself to death' because one thinks: 'For society as a whole the loss of even the best individual is merely a small sacrifice! Too bad that the sacrifice is necessary! It would surely be much worse though if the individual had thought otherwise and considered his own preservation and development more important than his work in the service of society!' And so one feels sorry for this youth, not for his own sake but because a devoted too/, ruthless towards itself — a so-called 'good man' — has been lost to society through his death. Perhaps one also asks whether it would not have been more useful to society if he had worked in a way that was less negligent towards himself and had preserved himself longer — yes, one admits that there would have been some advantage in that, but considers this other advantage to be greater and more last; that a sacrifice was made and the ethos of the sacrificial animal once again vindicated for all to see. What is, therefore, first really praised when virtues are praised is their instrumental nature and then the blind drive in every virtue that refuses to be held in check by the overall advantage of the individual — in short, the unreason in virtue that leads the individual to allow himself to be transformed into a mere function of the whole. The praise of virtues is the praise of something privately harmful — the praise of drives which deprive a human being of his noblest selfishness and of the strength for the highest form of self- protection. For the sake of inculcating and incorporating virtuous habits into people, to be sure, one emphasizes various effects of virtue that make virtue and private advantage appear as sisters — and there is in fact such a relationship! Blindly raging industriousness, for example — this typical virtue of an instrument — is represented as the road to riches and honour and as the best poison for curing boredom and the passions; but one keeps silent about its danger, its extreme dangerousness. That is how education always proceeds: it tries to condition the individual through various attractions and advantages to

adopt a way of thinking and behaving that, when it has become habit, drive and passion, will rule in him and over him against his ultimate advantage but ‘for the common good’. How often I see it: that blindly raging industriousness brings riches and honour but at the same time deprives the organs of refinement that make it possible to enjoy the riches and honour; also, that this chief antidote to boredom and to the passions at the same time 44 Book One dulls the senses and makes the spirit resistant to new attractions. (The most industrious age — our own — doesn’t know how to make anything of all its industriousness and money except still more money and still more industriousness; for more genius is required to spend than to acquire! — Well, we’ll still have our ‘grandchildren’!) If education is successful, each virtue of the individual is a public utility and a private disadvantage with respect to the highest private end — probably involving some deterioration of the spirit and the senses or even a premature demise: consider from this standpoint the virtues of obedience, chastity, piety, and justice. The praise of the selfless, the self-sacrificing, the virtuous — that is, of the person who does not apply his entire strength and reason to his own preservation, development, elevation, promotion, and expansion of power, but rather lives, as regards himself, modestly and thoughtlessly, maybe even with indifference and irony — this praise is certainly not born out of the spirit of selflessness! The ‘neighbour’ praises selflessness because it brings him advantages! If the neighbour himself thought ‘selflessly’, he would reject this decrease in strength, this harm for his benefit; he would work against the development of such inclinations, and above all he would affirm his selflessness by not calling it good! Hereby we hint at the fundamental contradiction in the morality that is very much honoured just now: the motives to this morality stand in opposition to its principle! What this morality wants to use as its proof, it refutes with its criterion of what is moral! In order not to contradict itself, the command ‘You shall renounce yourself and sacrifice yourself’ could be proclaimed only by a being which thereby renounced its own advantage and perhaps, through the demanded sacrifice of the individual, brought about its own destruction. But as soon as the neighbour (or society) recommends altruism for the sake of its utility, it is using the directly opposed principle, ‘You shall seek your advantage even at the expense of everything else’ — and thus one preaches, in the same breath, a “Thou shalt” and a “Thou shalt not”! 22 L’ordre du jour pour le roi.’2 — The day begins: let us begin to organize for this day the business and festivities of our most gracious master who 12 The king’s schedule for the day’ 45 The Gay Science is still deigning to repose. His majesty has bad weather today: we shall be careful not to call it bad; we shall not speak of the weather — but we shall be a bit more ceremonious about the business than would otherwise be necessary and a bit more festive about the festivities. His majesty may even be ill: at breakfast we shall present the latest good news of last evening, the arrival of Mr

Montaigne, who jokes so agreeably about his illness; he's suffering from a stone.!' We shall receive a few persons (persons! What that puffed-up old frog who will be among them would say if he heard this word! 'I am not a person', he would say, 'but always the matter itself'!*) — and this reception will take longer than anyone finds agreeable: that is reason enough to tell about the poet who wrote on his door, 'Whoever enters here will pay me an honour; whoever does not — a pleasure.'!> Truly a polite way to express a rudeness! And perhaps this poet is for his part quite right in being rude: they say his poems are better than their maker. Well, then let him write many more and withdraw himself from the world as much as possible — that is after all the meaning of his civil incivility! Conversely, a prince is always worth more than his 'verse', even if — but what are we doing? We are gossiping and the whole court thinks we are already working and racking our brains — one sees no light earlier than the one burning in our window. Listen! Wasn't that the bell? Damn! The day and the dance are beginning and we don't know the programme! So we have to improvise — the whole world improvises its day. Let's just do today as the whole world does! And there my strange morning dream vanished, probably the victim of the hard strokes of the tower bell, which just announced the fifth hour with all of its customary importance. It seems to me that this time the god of dreams wanted to poke fun at my habit of starting the day by organizing it and making it tolerable to myself, and it may well be that I have often done this in too formal and princelike a manner.

13 French moralist (1533-92) who discusses the pains (and pleasures) of his affliction in his essay 'Of Experience' 14 Perhaps a reference to Montaigne's letter 'To the Reader', printed as introduction to his Essays 15 In his notebook Nietzsche writes that this refers to 'Augier'; probably Emile Augier (1820-89), minor French dramatist who wrote on classical topics.

46 Book One 23 The signs of corruption. — Consider the following signs of those states of society that are necessary from time to time and that are designated by the word 'corruption'. As soon as corruption sets in anywhere, a colourful superstition takes over, and the previous common faith of a people becomes pale and powerless against it: for superstition is free-spiritedness of the second rank — whoever succumbs to it selects certain forms and formulas that appeal to him and allows himself some freedom of choice. The superstitious person is always, compared to the religious person, much more of a 'person', and a superstitious society will be one in which there are many individuals and much delight in individuality. From this perspective, superstition always appears as progress against faith and as a sign that the intellect is becoming more independent and demanding its rights. Those who then complain about corruption are the devotees of the old religion and religiosity — until now they have also determined linguistic usage and given superstition a bad name even among the freest spirits. Let us realize that it is actually a symptom of

enlightenment. Secondly, a society in which corruption spreads is accused of laxity; and it is obvious that the esteem of war and the pleasure in war diminish, while the comforts of life are now desired just as ardently as were warlike and athletic honours formerly. What is usually overlooked, however, is that the ancient civil energy and passion, which received a magnificent visibility through war and competitive games, has now transformed itself into countless private passions and has merely become less visible; indeed, in times of ‘corruption’ the power and force of a people’s expended energies are probably greater than ever, and the individual spends them on a lavish scale which he could not previously have afforded — when he was not yet rich enough! And thus it is precisely in times of ‘laxness’ that tragedy runs through the houses and streets, that great love and great hatred are born and the flame of knowledge blazes up into the sky. Thirdly, it is usually said to the credit of such societies, as if one wanted to compensate for the reproaches of superstition and laxness, that they are milder and that cruelty declines drastically in comparison to the older, stronger, more devout age. But this praise I cannot endorse any more than the reproaches: I concede only that cruelty now refines itself and that its older forms henceforth offend taste; but wounding and torturing with 47 The Gay Science word and eye reaches its highest cultivation in times of corruption — it is now alone that malice and the delight in malice are born. People who live in an age of corruption are witty and slanderous; they know that there are other kinds of murder than by dagger or assault; they also know that whatever is well said is believed. Fourthly, when ‘morals decay’, those beings emerge for the first time who are called tyrants: they are the precursors and as it were the precocious firstling instances of individuals. Just a little bit longer and this fruit of fruits hangs ripe and yellow on the tree of a people — and this tree existed only for the sake of this fruit! Once decay has reached its peak along with the struggle of all sorts of tyrants, the Caesar always appears, the final tyrant who puts an end to the weary wrestling for sole rule by putting weariness to work for himself. In his age the individual is usually ripest and culture is therefore at its highest and most fruitful stage, but not for the sake of him and not through him, though those of the highest culture like to flatter their Caesar by claiming to be his work. In truth they need peace from without because they have enough unrest and work within. In these times, bribery and treason are at their peak, for the love of the newly discovered ego is now much mightier than the love of the old, used-up, touted-to-death ‘fatherland’, and the need to secure oneself from the terrible ups and downs of luck opens even noble hands as soon as someone who is mighty and wealthy shows himself willing to pour gold into them. There is now so very little secure future; one lives for today: a state of soul that makes an easy game for all seducers, for one allows oneself to be seduced and bribed only ‘for today’ and reserves the future and virtue for oneself! As is well known the individuals, these

true 'in~and-for-themselves', care more about the moment than do their opposites, the herd people, for they consider themselves just as unpredictable as the future. They also like to join up with people of violence because they think themselves capable of actions and information which the common people would neither understand nor forgive, while the tyrant or Caesar would understand the rights of the individual even in his excesses and has an interest in advocating and even abetting a bolder private morality. For he thinks of himself and wants his self to be thought of as Napoleon once expressed it in his classic manner : 'I have the right to answer all charges against me with an eternal "'That is me." I am apart from all the world and accept conditions from no one. I want people to submit even to my fantasies and to find it natural when I yield 48 Book One to this or that distraction.' That is what Napoleon once replied to his wife when she had reasons to question her husband's marital fidelity. !® Times of corruption are those in which the apples fall from the tree: I mean the individuals, the seed-bearers of the future, the spiritual colonizers and shapers of new states and communities. Corruption is just a rude word for the autumn of a people. 24 Different forms of dissatisfaction. - The weak and, as it were, feminine discontented types are those who are innovative at making life more beautiful and profound; the strong discontents — the men among them, to stick with the metaphor — are innovative at making it better and safer. The former show their weakness and femininity by gladly letting themselves be deceived from time to time and occasionally resting content with a bit of intoxication and gushing enthusiasm, though they can never be satisfied entirely and suffer from the incurability of their dissatisfaction; they are also the promoters of all who know how to procure opiates and narcotic consolations, and consequently they resent those who esteem physicians above priests — thus they assure the continuance of real distress! Had there not been a surplus of these discontents in Europe since the middle ages, the celebrated European capacity for constant transformation might never have developed, for the demands of the strong discontents are too crude and basically too undemanding not eventually to be brought to a final rest. China, for example, is a country where large-scale discontentment and the capacity for change became extinct centuries ago; and in Europe too the socialists and state idolaters, with their measures for making life better and safer, might easily establish Chinese conditions and a Chinese 'happiness', provided they are first able to extirpate that sicklier, more tender, more feminine discontentment and romanticism that is for the moment still superabundant here. Europe is a patient who owes the utmost gratitude to his incurability and to the perpetual changes in his affliction: these incessantly new conditions, these no less incessantly new dangers, pains, and modes of information have finally generated an intellectual 16 Reported in *Mémoires de Madame de Rémusat* (3 vols., Paris, 1879~80), vol. 1, pp. rf, a copy of which Nietzsche had in his library

49 The Gay Science irritability that approximates genius and that is in any case the mother of all genius. 25 Not predestined for knowledge. — There is a stupid humility that is by no means rare, and those afflicted with it are altogether unfit to become votaries of knowledge. For as soon as a person of this type perceives something striking, he turns on his heel, as it were, and says to himself, ‘You have made a mistake! Where were your senses? This cannot be the truth! And then, instead of looking and listening more keenly again, he runs away, as if intimidated, from the striking thing and tries to shake it from his mind as fast as possible. For his inner canon says: ‘I want to see nothing that contradicts the prevalent opinion. Am I made to discover new truths? There are already too many old ones.’ 26 What is life? — Life — that is: continually shedding something that wants to die; Life — that is: being cruel and inexorable against anything that is growing weak and old in us, and not just in us. Life — therefore means: being devoid of respect for the dying, the wretched, the aged? Always being a murderer? And yet old Moses said: ‘Thou shalt not kill.’! 27 The renouncer. — What does the renouncer do? He strives for a higher world, he wants to fly further and higher than all affirmers — he throws away much that would encumber his flight, including some things that are not valueless, not disagreeable to him: he sacrifices it to his desire for the heights. This sacrificing, this throwing away, is now precisely what alone becomes visible in him and leads people to call him the renouncer, and thus he stands before us, shrouded in his hood as if he were the soul of a hairshirt. But he is quite satisfied with the impression that he makes on us: he wants to conceal from us his desire, his pride, his intention to soar beyond us. Yes, he is cleverer than we thought, and so polite 7 Moses was the supposed author of the Pentateuch, the first five books of the Bible which include, in Exodus, 20, the Ten Commandments. 50 Book One towards us — this affirmer! For he is just as we are even in his renunciation. 28 Harming with what is best in oneself. — At times our strengths propel us so far ahead that we can no longer stand our weaknesses and perish from them. We may even foresee this outcome and still will have it no other way. Thus we become hard against that within us that wants to be spared, and our greatness is also our mercilessness. Such an experience, for which we must in the end pay with our lives, is a parable for the whole effect of great human beings on others and on their age: precisely with what is best in them, with what only they can do, they destroy many who are weak, insecure, in the process of becoming, of willing, and thus they are harmful. It can even happen that, all in all, they are harmful only because what is best in them is accepted and as it were imbibed only by those whom it affects like an overly potent drink: they lose their mind and their selfishness; they become so intoxicated that they are bound to break their limbs on all the wrong paths down which their intoxication drives them. 29 The add-on-liars. — When people in France started to fight the Aristotelian

unities'® and others consequently also started to defend them, one could see again something that is so often apparent but that people are loath to see: one lied to oneself, inventing reasons for these laws, simply to avoid admitting that one had become used to them and would no longer have it any other way. And that is what one does, and has always done, within every prevailing morality and religion: the reasons and intents behind habits are invented only when some people start attacking the habits and asking for reasons and intents. Here we have the great dishonesty of conservatives of all times — they are the add-on-liars. 18 In seventeenth-century France aestheticians (mis)read Aristotle (see his *Poetics*, esp. chapter 8 {1451a.16—35}) as requiring that a tragedy exhibit unity of time, place, and plot. 51 The Gay Science 30 The comedy of the famous. — Famous men who need their fame, e.g. all politicians, never choose allies and friends without ulterior motives: from one they want a piece of the splendour and reflected splendour of his virtue; from another the fear-inspiring aspects of certain dubious qualities that everyone knows him to have; from another they steal the reputation of his idleness, his lying in the sun, because it serves their own ends to appear inattentive and sluggish at times — it conceals the fact that they actually lie in wait; now they need a visionary around; now an expert; now a thinker; now a pedant, as if he were their present self; but just as quickly they don't need them any more! And so the surroundings and exteriors of famous men die off continually, even while everything seems to be pushing to get into these surroundings and lend them their character; in this, they are like big cities. Their reputation is continually changing, like their character, for their changing methods demand these changes and push forward now this, now that real or fictitious characteristic onto the stage. Their friends and allies belong, as I said, to these stage properties. What they want, however, must stand all the much more firmly and unshakeably and be splendidly seen from afar; and this, too, sometimes requires its comedy and its theatrics. 31 Trade and nobility. — Buying and selling are common by now, like the art of reading and writing; everyone has practised it, even if he is not a tradesman, and gets more practice at this technique every day — just as formerly, in the age of a more savage humanity, everyone was a hunter and practised the technique of hunting every day. In that age, hunting was common; but eventually it became a privilege and thereby lost its everyday and common character — because it stopped being necessary and became a thing of moods and luxury. The same thing could happen to buying and selling one day. One can imagine social conditions in which there is no buying and selling and in which this technique gradually becomes unnecessary. Perhaps some individuals who are not as subject to the laws of the general condition will then give themselves permission to buy and sell as a luxury of sentiment. Only then would 52 Book One trade become something exquisite, and the noble might enjoy trade as much as they hitherto enjoyed war and politics, while conversely

the assessment of politics could have changed completely. Even now it is ceasing to be the art of the nobleman, and it is quite possible that some day one will find it so base that, along with all political literature and journalism, one classifies it as a 'prostitution of the spirit'. 32 Undesired disciples. ~ 'What can I do with these two young men!' cried an irritated philosopher who 'corrupted' the youth as Socrates once had done;! they are unwelcome students. This one can't say 'no' and the other one says 'half and half' about everything. If they adopted my doctrine, the first would suffer too much, for my way of thinking requires a warlike soul, a desire to hurt, a delight in saying no, a hard skin; he would languish from open and internal wounds. And the other would strike a compromise with everything he represents and thereby make it into a mediocrity — such a disciple I wish on my enemies. 33 Outside the lecture-room. — 'In order to prove to you that man is fundamentally a good-natured animal, I would remind you of how credulous he has been for so long. Only now, quite late and after tremendous self-conquest, has he become a distrustful animal. Yes, man is now more evil than ever.' I do not understand this: why should man be more distrustful and evil now? 'Because he now has a science — needs a science.' 34 *Historia abscondita.*"® — Every great human being exerts a retroactive force: for his sake all of history is put on the scale again, and a thousand secrets of the past crawl out of their hiding places — into As sunshine. There is no telling what may yet become a part of history. Maybe the 19 One of the charges on which Socrates was condemned to death was that of 'corrupting the youth'; see Plato, *Apology* 24 b—c. 20 'hidden history' 53 The Gay Science past is still essentially undiscovered! So many retroactive forces are still needed! 35 Heresy and witchcraft. - To think otherwise than is customary is much less the effect of a superior intellect than of strong, evil inclinations — detaching, isolating, defiant, gloating, and malicious inclinations. Heresy is the adjunct of witchcraft and surely no more harmless and least of all anything venerable. Heretics and witches are two species of evil people; what they have in common is that they also feel evil but are impelled by an unconquerable lust to harm what is prevailing (people or opinions). The Reformation, which was a kind of redoubling of the medieval spirit at a time when it was no longer accompanied by a good conscience, produced both in the greatest abundance. 36 Last words. ~ One will recall that the emperor Augustus, that frightful man who had as much self-control and who could be as silent as any wise Socrates, became indiscreet against himself with his last words: he let his mask fall for the first time when he made it clear that he had worn a mask and acted a comedy — he had played the father of the fatherland and the wisdom on the throne well enough to create the proper illusion! *Plaudite amici, comoedia finita est!* The thought of the dying Nero — *qualis artifex pereo?** — was also the thought of the dying Augustus: actor's vanity! Actor's prolixity! And truly the opposite of the dying Socrates!"> But

Tiberius died silently, this most tormented of all self-tormentors — #e was genuine and no actor! What might have passed through his mind at the end? Maybe this: ‘Life — that is a long death. What a fool I was to shorten so many lives! Was I made to be a benefactor? I should have given them eternal /ife: that way, I could have seen them die forever. That’s why I had such good eyes: qualis spectator 21 ‘Father of the Fatherland’ was an honorary title bestowed by the Roman Senate on the emperor Augustus. In his biography (chapter gg} Suetonius reports that these Latin words (= ‘Applaud, my friends, the comedy is over!)) were among the last Augustus spoke on his deathbed. 22 “I die, what a loss to art!’ (as reported by Suetonius, *Life of Nero*, chapter 49) 23 Socrates insisted that a decorous silence be preserved while he was being executed; see Plato, *Phaedo* 117c~e, but see below, § 340, p. 193. 54 Book One pereó? When after a long death-struggle he seemed to recover his strength, it was considered advisable to smother him with pillows — he died a double death.?’ 37 Because of three errors. - One has promoted science during the last centuries partly because it was through science that one hoped best to understand God’s goodness and wisdom — the main motive in the soul of the great Englishmen (such as Newton);”° partly because one believed in the absolute usefulness of knowledge, especially in the most intimate affiliation between morality, knowledge, and happiness — the main motive in the soul of the French (such as Voltaire);?” and partly because one believed that in science one had and loved something selfless, harmless, self-sufficient, and truly innocent in which the evil drives of humanity had no part at all — the main motive in the soul of Spinoza,”® who felt divine in attaining knowledge — in sum, because of three errors. 38 The explosive ones. — When one considers how the energy of young men needs to explode, one is not surprised to see them decide so unsubtly and so unselectively for this or that cause: what thrills them is the sight of the zeal surrounding a cause and, so to speak, the sight of the burning match — not the cause itself. The subtler seducers therefore know how to create in them the expectation of an explosion and to disregard justifying their cause: reasons are not the way to win over these powder kegs! 39 Changed taste. - Change in common taste is more important than that in opinions; opinions along with proofs, refutations, and the whole 24 ‘I die, but what a good observer I was!’ 25 Tiberius’ end is described in Suetonius, *Life of Tiberius* (chapter 73) and in Tacitus, *Annals* VI.50. 6 English physicist and mathematician (1643~—1727) 27 Paradigmatic French rationalist of the Enlightenment (1694~1778) 28 Jewish philosopher who lived most of his life in Amsterdam (1632-77) 55 The Gay Science intellectual masquerade are only symptoms of a changed taste and most certainly not what they are so often taken to be, its causes. How does common taste change? Through individuals — powerful, influential, and without any sense of shame — who announce and tyrannically enforce their hoc est ridiculum, hoc est absurdum,?? i.e. the

judgement of their taste and disgust: thus they put many under pressure, which gradually turns into a habit among even more and finally becomes a need of everyone. The reason why these individuals sense and ‘taste’ differently is usually found in a peculiarity of their lifestyle, nutrition, digestion, maybe a deficit or excess of inorganic salts in their blood and brains — in short, in their physis:°° they have the courage to own up to their physis and to heed its demands down to its subtlest tones. Their aesthetic and moral judgements are such ‘subtlest tones’ of the physis. 40 On the lack of noble style. — Soldiers and leaders still have a far higher relation to one another than do workers and employers. So far at least, all cultures with a military basis are still high above so-called industrial culture: the latter in its present form is altogether the most vulgar form of existence that has ever been. Here it is simply the law of need operating: one wants to live and has to sell oneself, but one despises those who exploit this need and dupe the worker. It is strange that submission to powerful, frightening, yes, terrifying persons, to tyrants and generals, is experienced to be not nearly as distressing as this submission to unknown and uninteresting persons, which is what all the greats of industry are: the worker usually sees in the employer only a cunning, bloodsucking dog of a man who speculates on all distress and whose name, figure, manner, and reputation are completely indifferent to him. So far the manufacturers and large-scale commercial entrepreneurs have apparently been much too lacking in all the manners and signs of higher race that alone enable a person to become interesting; if they had the refinement of noble breeding in their eye and gesture, there might not be any socialism of the masses. For the masses are basically prepared to submit to any kind of slavery provided that the superiors constantly legitimize themselves as higher, as born to command — 29 ‘This is ridiculous, this is absurd.’ 30 Greek for ‘nature’ 56 Book One through refined demeanour! The commonest man senses that refinement cannot be improvised and that one has to honour in it the fruit of long ages — but the absence of the higher demeanour and the notorious manufacturer’s vulgarity with ruddy, plump hands give him the idea that it is only accident and luck that elevated one above the other in this case: well, then, he infers, let us try accident and luck! Let us throw the dice! — and socialism begins. 41 Against remorse. ~- The thinker sees his own actions as experiments and questions, as seeking explanations of something: to him, success and failure are primarily answers To be vexed or even to feel remorse because something goes wrong — he leaves that to those who act because they were ordered to do so and who expect a beating when his gracious lordship is not pleased with the result. 42 Work and boredom. — Seeking work for the sake of wages — in this, nearly all people in civilized countries are alike; to all of them, work is just a means and not itself the end, which is why they are unrefined in their choice of work, provided it yields an ample reward. Now there are rare individuals who

would rather perish than work without taking pleasure in their work: they are choosy, hard to please, and have no use for ample rewards if the work is not itself the reward of rewards. To this rare breed belong artists and contemplative men of all kinds, but also men of leisure who spend their lives hunting, travelling, in love affairs, or on adventures. All of them want work and misery as long as it is joined with pleasure, and the heaviest, hardest work, if need be. Otherwise they are resolutely idle, even if it spells impoverishment, dishonour, and danger to life and limb. They do not fear boredom as much as work without pleasure; indeed, they need a lot of boredom if their work is to succeed. For the thinker and for all inventive spirits, boredom is that disagreeable ‘lull’ of the soul that precedes a happy voyage and cheerful winds; he has to endure it, must await its effect on him — precisely that is what lesser natures are totally unable to achieve! To fend off boredom at any price is vulgar, just as work without pleasure is vulgar.

Perhaps 57 The Gay Science Asians are distinguished as above Europeans by their capacity for a longer, deeper calm; even their narcotics work slowly and require patience, in contrast to the revolting suddenness of the European poison, alcohol. 43 What the laws betray. — It is a grave error to study a people’s penal code as if it were an expression of its character; the laws do not betray what a people is but rather what appears to it as foreign, strange, uncanny, outlandish. The laws concern the exceptions to the morality of custom (*Sittlichkeit der Sitte*)*’, and the severest punishments are for things that accord with the customs of the neighbouring people. Thus the Waha- nabis*? have only two mortal sins: having a god other than the Wahanabi god and — smoking (which they call ‘the disgraceful way of drinking’). ‘And what about murder and adultery?’ asked the Englishman, amazed, who found this out. ‘God is gracious and merciful’, the old chief replied. Thus the old Romans had the notion that a woman could commit only two mortal sins: adultery and — drinking wine. Old Cato thought that kissing among relatives had been made into a custom only in order to keep the women under control in this regard; a kiss meant, ‘Does she smell of wine??? Women caught with wine were actually put to death; and certainly not just because sometimes women under the influence of wine completely forgot how to say no; above all, the Romans feared the orgiastic and Dionysian cult which afflicted the women of southern Europe from time to time when wine was still new in Europe — feared it as a foreign monster that overthrew the basis of Roman sensibility; to them it seemed like a betrayal of Rome, like the embodiment of the foreign. 31 Nietzsche here uses the expression *Sittlichkeit der Sitte*, and similar phrases occur elsewhere (e.g. in § 46, *die Sitte der Sittlichkeit*). Hegel had distinguished between *Sittlichkeit*, the ethical outlook embodied in a society’s customary practice, and *Moralität*, an abstract, reflective, code such as that insisted upon in Kant’s philosophy. It is unclear, but unlikely, that Nietzsche was aware of Hegel’s own particular version of this distinction, but Nietzsche’s

formulations emphasize strongly the customary aspect of traditional ethical life. 32 Islamic sect in central Arabia. The anecdote which follows is taken from William Gifford Palgrave's *A Narrative of a Year's Journey through Central and Eastern Arabia 1862-1863* (translated into German in 1867~8). 33 Reported in Plutarch's *Quaestiones romanae*, 6. 58 Book One 44 The supposed motives. — Important as it may be to know the motives from which humanity has acted so far, it might be even more essential to know the delief people had in this or that motive, i.e. what humanity has imagined and told itself to be the real lever of its conduct so far. For people's inner happiness and misery has come to them depending on their belief in this or that motive — not through the actual motives. The latter are of second-order interest. 45 Epicurus. — Yes, | am proud to experience Epicurus' character in a way unlike perhaps anyone else and to enjoy, in everything I hear and read of him, the happiness of the afternoon of antiquity: I see his eye gaze at a wide whitish sea, across shoreline rocks bathed in the sun, as large and small creatures play in its light, secure and calm like the light and his eye itself. Only someone who is continually suffering could invent such happiness — the happiness of an eye before which the sea of existence has grown still and which now cannot get enough of seeing the surface and this colourful, tender, quivering skin of the sea: never before has voluptuousness been so modest. 46 Our amazement. — It is a deep and fundamental stroke of luck that science discovers things that stand up under examination and _ that furnish the basis, again and again, for further discoveries — after all, it could be otherwise! Indeed, we are so convinced of the uncertainty and the fantastical quality of our judgements and of the eternal change of human laws and concepts that it actually amazes us how well the results of science stand up! Formerly, one knew nothing of the changeableness of everything human; the habit of attachment to customary morality (*Sitte der Sittlichkeit*) sustained the faith that the entire inner life of 34 Late fourth-century Bc Athenian philosopher who held that pleasure (correctly understood) was the goal of human life. This paragraph is probably influenced by Lucretius, *On the Nature of Things*, Bk. 11, 1-61, which describes the effects to be expected from following the Epicurean doctrine. 59 The Gay Science humanity was fastened to iron necessity with eternal clamps; perhaps people then experienced a similarly voluptuous amazement when they told each other stories and fairy tales. The miraculous did a lot of good to those who at times grew weary of the rule and of eternity. To lose firm ground for once! To float! To err! To be mad! — that was part of the paradise and debauchery of former ages, whereas our bliss is like that of the shipwrecked man who has climbed ashore and is standing with both feet on the firm old earth — marvelling because it does not bob up and down. 47 On the suppression of the passions. — If one constantly forbids oneself the expression of the passions, as if that were something to be left for the 'common', coarser, middle-class, peasant

types — i.e. if one wants to suppress not the passions themselves but only their language and gesture — one still attains in addition what one did not desire: the suppression of the passions themselves, at least their weakening and alteration — the most instructive example being furnished by the court of Louis XIV and everything that depended on it. The age that followed, brought up in the suppression of expression, no longer had the passions themselves and had in their place a graceful, shallow, playful manner — an age marked by an incapacity for bad manners, so that even an insult was accepted and returned with obliging words. Perhaps the present age supplies the most notable counterpart: everywhere, in life and on the stage, and not the least in everything written, I see the delight in all the coarser outbursts and gestures of passion: what is demanded these days is a certain convention of the passionate — but not passion itself! Nevertheless, eventually passion itself will be reached this way, and our progeny will be genuinely savage and not just savage and unruly in demeanour. 48

Knowledge of distress. - Perhaps nothing separates human beings or ages from each other more than the different degrees of their knowledge of distress — distress of the soul as well as of the body. Regarding the latter we moderns may well, in spite of our frailties and fragilities, be bunglers and dreamers owing to lack of ample first-hand experience, compared 60 Book One with an age of fear, the longest of all ages, when individuals had to protect themselves against violence and to that end had themselves to become men of violence. In those days, a man received ample training in bodily torments and deprivations and understood that even a certain cruelty towards himself, as a voluntary exercise in pain, was a necessary means of his preservation; in those days, one trained one's surroundings to endure pain; in those days, one gladly inflicted pain and saw the most terrible things of this kind happen to others without any other feeling than that of one's own safety. As regards the distress of the soul, however, I look at each person today to see whether he knows it through experience or description; whether he still considers it necessary to fake this knowledge, say, as a sign of refined cultivation, or whether at the bottom of his soul he no longer believes in great pains of the soul and reacts to its mention in much the same way as to the mention of great bodily sufferings, which make him think of his toothaches and stomach-aches. But that is how most people seem to me to be these days. The general inexperience with both sorts of pain and the relative rarity of the sight of suffering individuals have an important consequence: pain is hated much more now than formerly; one speaks much worse of it; indeed, one can hardly endure the presence of pain as a thought and makes it a matter of conscience and a reproach against the whole of existence. The emergence of pessimistic philosophers is in no way the sign of great, terrible states of distress; rather, these question marks about the value of all life are made in times when the refinement and ease of existence make even the inevitable mosquito bites of the soul and the

body seem much too bloody and malicious, and the poverty of real experiences of pain makes one tend to consider painful general ideas as already suffering of the highest rank. There is a recipe against pessimistic philosophies and excessive sensitivity, things which seem to me to be the real 'distress of the present' — but this recipe may sound too cruel and would itself be counted among the signs that lead people to judge, 'existence is something evil'. Well, the recipe against this 'distress' is: distress. 49 Magnanimity and related things. - Those paradoxical phenomena, like the sudden coldness in the behaviour of the emotional person, or the 61 The Gay Science humour of the melancholy person, or above all magnanimity as a sudden renunciation of revenge or a satisfaction of envy, appear in people who have a powerful inner centrifugal force, in people of sudden satiety and sudden nausea. Their satisfactions are so quick and strong that they are immediately followed by weariness and aversion and a flight into the opposite taste: in this opposite, the cramp of feeling is resolved — in one person by sudden cold, in another by laughter, in a third by tears and self-sacrifice. The magnanimous person — at least the type of magnanimous person who has always made the strongest impression — strikes me as a person with a most extreme thirst for vengeance, who sees satisfaction nearby and drinks it down already in imagination so fully, thoroughly and to the last drop that a tremendous, quick nausea follows this quick excess and he now rises 'above himself', as they say, and forgives his enemy, indeed blesses and honours him. With this rape of himself, with this mockery of his drive for revenge he only gives in to the new drive which just now has become powerful in him (disgust), and he does so just as impatiently and excessively as just a moment ago he imaginatively anticipated and, as it were, exhausted his delight in revenge. Magnanimity has the same degree of egoism as revenge, only egoism of a different quality. 50 The argument from growing solitary. - The reproach of conscience is weak in even the most conscientious people compared to the feeling: 'This or that is against the morals (die gute Sitte) of your society.' Even the strongest person still fears a cold look or a sneer on the face of those among whom and for whom he has been brought up. What is he really afraid of? Growing solitary! This is the argument that refutes even the best arguments for a person or a cause. — Thus the herd instinct speaks out in us. 51 The sense of truth. - | approve of any form of scepticism to which I can reply, 'Let's try it!' But I want to hear nothing more about all the things and questions that don't admit of experiment. This is the limit of my 'sense of truth'; for there, courage has lost its right. 62 Book One 52 What others know about us. — What we know about ourselves and remember is not as decisive to our life's happiness as it is believed to be. One day, what others know (or think they know) about us assails us ~ and then we realize that that is more powerful. It is easier to deal with a bad conscience than a bad reputation. 53 Where the good begins. ~ At the point where the poor power of the eye is no

longer able to see the evil drive as such, owing to its increasing subtlety, man posits the realm of goodness; and the feeling of now having stepped into the land of goodness excites all those impulses that had been threatened and limited by the evil drive, such as the feeling of security, of comfort, of benevolence. So: the duller the eye, the more extensive the good! Hence the eternal cheerfulness of the common people and of children! Hence the gloominess and grief — akin to a bad conscience — of the great thinkers! 54 The consciousness of appearance. ~ How wonderful and new and yet how fearful and ironic my new insight makes me feel towards all of existence! I have discovered for myself that the ancient humanity and animality, indeed the whole prehistory and past of all sentient being, continues within me to fabulate, to love, to hate, and to infer — I suddenly awoke in the middle of this dream, but only to the consciousness that I am dreaming and that I must go on dreaming lest I perish — as the sleepwalker has to go on dreaming in order to avoid falling down. What is ‘appearance’ to me now! Certainly not the opposite of some essence — what could I say about any essence except name the predicates of its appearance! Certainly not a dead mask that one could put on an unknown x and probably also take off x! To me, appearance is the active and living itself, which goes so far in its self-mockery that it makes me feel that here there is appearance and a will-o’-the-wisp and a dance of spirits and nothing else — that among all these dreamers, even I, the ‘knower’, am dancing my dance; that the one who comes to know is a 63 The Gay Science means of prolonging the earthly dance and thus is one of the masters of ceremony of existence, and that the sublime consistency and interrelatedness of all knowledge may be and will be the highest means to sustain the universality of dreaming, the mutual comprehension of all dreamers, and thereby also the duration of the dream. 55 The ultimate noblemindedness. — So what makes a person ‘noble’? Certainly not making sacrifices; even those burning with lust make sacrifices, Certainly not following some passion, for there are contemptible passions. Certainly not that one does something for others without selfishness: perhaps no one is more consistently selfish than the noble one. — Rather, the passion that overcomes the noble one is a singularity, and he fails to realize this: the use of a rare and singular standard and almost a madness; the feeling of heat in things that feel cold to everyone else; a hitting upon values for which the scale has not yet been invented; a sacrifice on altars made for an unknown god; a courage without any desire for honours; a self-sufficiency that overflows and communicates to men and things. Hitherto, then, it was rarity and the unawareness of this rarity that made noble. Note, however, that by means of this standard everything usual, near, and indispensable, in short, that which most preserved the species, and in general the rule of humanity hitherto, was inequitably judged and on the whole slandered in favour of the exceptions. To become the advocate of the rule — that might be the ultimate

form and refinement in which noblemindedness manifests itself on earth. 56 The desire for suffering. — When I think of the desire to do something, how it continually tickles and goads the millions of young Europeans who cannot endure boredom and themselves, I realize that they must have a yearning to suffer something in order to make their suffering a likely reason for action, for deeds. Neediness is needed! Hence the clamour of the politicians; hence the many false, fictitious, exaggerated ‘emergencies’ of all kinds and the blind readiness to believe in them. This young world demands that not happiness, but unhappiness should 64 Book One approach or become visible from outside; and its imagination is already busy turning this unhappiness into a monster ahead of time so that afterwards it can fight a monster. Were these distress-addicts to feel within themselves the power to do themselves good from within, to do something for themselves, they would know how to create their very own distress. Their inventions could then become more refined and their satisfactions sound like good music, while they now fill the world with their clamour about distress, and consequently, all too often with the feeling of distress! They do not know what to do with themselves — and so they paint the unhappiness of others on the wall; they always need others! And continually other others! — Pardon me, my friends, I have ventured to paint my Aappiness on the wall.*° 33 A reversal of the German expression ‘Don’t paint the devil on the wall’ (because by doing so you will cause him to appear). 65 Book Two Book Two 57 To the realists. — You sober people who feel armed against passion and phantastical conceptions and would like to make your emptiness a matter of pride and an ornament — you call yourself realists and insinuate that the world really is the way it appears to you: before you alone reality stands unveiled, and you yourselves are perhaps the best part of it — oh, you beloved images of Sais!! But aren’t you too in your unveiled condition still most passionate and dark creatures, compared to fish, and still all too similar to an artist in love? And what is ‘reality’ to an artist in love! You still carry around the valuations of things that originate in the passions and loves of former centuries! Your sobriety still contains a secret and inextirpable drunkenness! Your love of ‘reality’, for example — oh, that is an old, ancient ‘love’! In every experience, in every sense impression there is a piece of this old love; and some fantasy, some prejudice, some irrationality, some ignorance, some fear, and whatever else, has worked on and contributed to it. That mountain over there! That cloud over there! What is ‘real’ about that? Subtract just once the phantasm and the whole human contribution from it, you sober ones! Yes, if you could do that! If you could forget your background, your past, your nursery school — all of your humanity and animality! There is no ‘reality’ for us — and not for you either, you sober ones — we are not nearly as strange to one another as you think, and perhaps our good will to transcend drunkenness is just as respectable as your belief that you are altogether incapable of drunkenness. 58

Only as creators! - This has caused me the greatest trouble and still does always cause me the greatest trouble: to realize that what things are called is unspeakably more important than what they are. The reputation, name, and appearance, the worth, the usual measure and weight of a thing — originally almost always something mistaken and arbitrary, thrown over things like a dress and quite foreign to their nature and even to their skin — has, through the belief in it and its growth from generation to generation, slowly grown onto and into the thing and has ! See above, ‘Preface’, footnote 5, p. 8. 69 The Gay Science become its very body: what started as appearance in the end nearly always becomes essence and effectively acts as its essence! What kind of a fool would believe that it is enough to point to this origin and this misty shroud of delusion in order to destroy the world that counts as ‘real’, so- called ‘reality’! Only as creators can we destroy! — But let us also not forget that in the long run it is enough to create new names and valuations and appearances of truth in order to create new ‘things’. 59 We artists. - When we love a woman, we easily come to hate nature because of all the repulsive natural functions to which every woman is subject; we prefer not to think about it at all, but when our soul for once brushes against these matters, it shrugs impatiently and, as just said, casts a contemptuous look at nature: we feel insulted; nature seems to intrude on our property and with the most profane hands at that. In cases like this one refuses to hear anything about physiology and decrees secretly to oneself, ‘I will hear nothing of the idea that the human being is anything other than soul and form!’ ‘The human being under the skin’ is an abomination and unthinkable to all lovers, a blasphemy against God and love. Now, the way lovers still feel about nature and naturalness is how every worshipper of God and his ‘holy omnipotence’ formerly felt: in everything that was said about nature by astronomers, geologists, physiologists, and doctors, he saw an intrusion on his choicest property and thus an attack — and a shameless one at that! Even the ‘law of nature’ sounded to him like a slander against God; he would basically much rather have seen all of mechanics traced back to moral acts of will and choice — but since no one could do him that service, he concealed nature and mechanics from himself as best he could and lived in a dream. Oh, these people of former times knew how to dream and didn’t even need to fall asleep first! - and we men of today also still know it all too well, despite all our good will towards waking and the day! We need only to love, to hate, to desire, simply to feel — at once the spirit and power of the dream comes over us, and we climb with open eyes, impervious to all danger, up the most dangerous paths, onto the roofs and towers of fantasy, and without any vertigo, as though born to climb — we sleepwalkers of the day! We artists! We who conceal naturalness! We who are moon- and God-struck! We untiring wan- 79 Book Two derers, silent as death, on heights that we see not as heights but as our plains, as our safety. 60 Women and

their action at a distance. - Do I still have ears? Am I all ear and nothing else? Here I stand amidst the fire of the surf, whose white flames are licking at my feet: from all sides it is howling, threatening, screaming, shrieking at me, while the old earth-rattler" sings his aria in the lowest of depths, deep as a roaring bull, while pounding such an earth-rattling beat that the hearts of even these weather-beaten monsters of the rocks are trembling in their bodies. Suddenly, as if born out of nothingness, there appears before the gate of this hellish labyrinth only a few fathoms away a large sailing ship, gliding along as silently as a ghost. Oh, this ghostly beauty! How magically it touches me! What? Has all the calm and silence of the world embarked here? Is my happiness itself sitting in this quiet place - my happier self, my second, immortalized self?? Not yet to be dead, but also no longer alive? As a spiritlike, silent, watching, gliding, hovering intermediate being? As though I were that ship that moves over the dark sea with its white sails like an enormous butterfly! Yes! To move over existence! That's it! That would be it! — It seems as though the noise here has made me into a dreamer? All great noise makes us place happiness in silence and distance. When a man stands in the midst of his own noise, in the midst of his own surf of projects and plans, he is also likely to see gliding past him silent, magical creatures whose happiness and seclusion he yearns for — women. He almost believes that his better self lives there amongst the women: in these quiet regions even the loudest surf turns into deathly silence and life itself into a dream about life. Yet! Yet! My noble enthusiast, even on the most beautiful sailing ship there is so much sound and noise, and unfortunately so much small, petty noise! The magic and the most powerful effect of women is, to speak the language of the philosophers, action at a distance, *actio in distans*:* but that requires, first and foremost — distance! 2 The standard epithet of the Greek god Poseidon, who was thought to rule the seas and be responsible for earthquakes, is 'earth-shaker' (see [Had V.445, VII.201, 1X.362, etc.]). 3 The German term Nietzsche uses here means both 'dead' and 'made immortal'. 4 'action at a distance' 71 The Gay Science 61 In honour of friendship. — That the feeling of friendship was in antiquity considered the highest feeling, even higher than the most celebrated pride of the self-sufficient sage, indeed, as it were, as its sole and even holier sibling: this is very well expressed in the story of the Macedonian king who gave a world-despising Athenian philosopher a talent and got it back. 'What?' said the king, 'Has he then no friend?>> He meant: 'I honour this pride of the wise and independent man, but I would honour his humanity even more highly if the friend in him had won over his pride. The philosopher has lowered himself before me by showing that he doesn't know one of the two highest feelings — and the higher one at that.' 62 Love. — Love forgives the beloved even his lust. 63 The woman in music. ~ Why do warm and rainy winds also bring on a musical mood and the inventive pleasure of melody? Are they not the same

winds that fill the churches and give women thoughts of love? 64 Sceptics. — I am afraid that old women in their most secret heart of hearts are more sceptical than all men: they believe the superficiality of existence to be its essence, and all virtue and depth is to them merely a veil over this ‘truth’, the very desirable veil over a pudendum — in other words, a matter of decency and shame, and no more! 65 Devotion. — There are noble women with a certain poverty of spirit who know no other way to express their deepest devotion than to offer their 5 A talent is a large sum of money. I have been unable to discover the origin of this story. 72 Book Two virtue and sense of shame: it is what they hold as their highest possession. And often this gift is accepted without incurring as profound an obligation as the donors suppose — a very melancholy story! 66 The strength of the weak. — All women are subtle at exaggerating their weaknesses; indeed they are inventive at weaknesses in order to appear as utterly fragile ornaments that are harmed by even a speck of dust: their way of living is supposed to remind men of their clumsiness and burden their conscience with this. Thus they defend themselves against the strong and ‘the law of the jungle’. 67 Feigning oneself. — She loves him now and gazes ahead with such calm confidence, like a cow. But alas! What bewitched him was precisely that she seemed utterly changeable and unfathomable! He already had too much steady weather in himself! Wouldn’t she do well to feign her old character? To feign lovelessness? Isn’t that the counsel of — love? Vivat comoedia!® 68 Will and willingness. - Someone took a youth to a wise man and said: “Look, he is being corrupted by women!’ The wise man shook his head and smiled. ‘It is men who corrupt women’, he exclaimed, ‘and the failings of women should be atoned for and set right in men ~ for man makes for himself the image (B:/d) of woman, and woman shapes herself (bildet sich) according to this image (B:/d)’. “You are too gentle towards women’, said one in the company; ‘you do not know them!’ The wise man replied, “The way of men is will; the way of women is willingness — that is the law of the sexes; truly a hard law for women! All human beings are innocent of their existence; women, however, are doubly innocent. Who could have oil and mercy enough for them?’ ‘Forget oil! Forget gentleness!’ shouted someone else from the crowd; ‘one has to © ‘Long live comedy!’” 73 The Gay Science raise women better!’ ‘One has to raise men better’, said the wise man and beckoned to the youth to follow him. — But the youth did not follow him. 69 Capacity for revenge. — That someone cannot defend himself and therefore also does not want to — this is not enough to disgrace him in our eyes; but we have a low regard for anyone who has neither the capacity nor the good will for revenge — regardless of whether it is a man or a woman. Would a woman be able to hold us (or ‘enthral’ us, as they say) if we did not consider her able under certain circumstances to wield a dagger deftly (any kind of dagger) against us? Or against herself — which in certain cases would be the more severe revenge

(Chinese revenge). 70 The women who master the masters. — A deep and powerful alto voice, such as one sometimes hears in the theatre, suddenly raises the curtain upon possibilities that we usually do not believe in. All at once we believe that somewhere in the world there could be women with lofty, heroic, royal souls, capable of and ready for grandiose retorts, resolutions, and sacrifices, capable of and ready for mastery over men, because in them the best of man aside from his sex has become an incarnate ideal. To be sure, the intention of the theatre is woz at all that such voices convey this concept of women; normally they are supposed to represent the ideal male lover, for example a Romeo; but to judge from my experience, the theatre quite regularly miscalculates on this point, as does the composer who expects such effects from such a voice. One does not believe in these lovers: such voices always retain a motherly and housewifely colouring, and most of all when love is in their tone. 71 On female chastity. - There is something quite amazing and monstrous in the upbringing of upper-class women; indeed, maybe there is nothing more paradoxical. The whole world agrees that they should be brought up as ignorant as possible about matters erotic, and that one has to impart in their souls a deep shame in the face of such things and the 74 Book Two most extreme impatience and flight at the merest suggestion of them. Really, in this matter alone the 'honour' of a woman in its entirety is at risk: what else would one not forgive them? But here they are supposed to remain ignorant deep in their hearts: they are supposed to have neither eyes, nor ears, nor words, nor thoughts for this their 'evil'; yes, even knowledge is here an evil. And then to be hurled as if by a gruesome lightning bolt into reality and knowledge, with marriage — and precisely by the man they love and esteem the most: to catch love and shame in a contradiction and to have to experience all at once delight, surrender, duty, pity, terror at the unexpected proximity of god and beast, and who knows what else! There one has tied a psychic knot that may have no equal. Even the compassionate curiosity of the wisest connoisseur of human psychology (Menschenkenner) is insufficient for guessing how this or that woman manages to accommodate herself to this solution of the riddle and to this riddle of a solution, and what dreadful, far-reaching suspicions must stir in her poor, unhinged soul; indeed, how the ultimate philosophy and scepticism of woman casts anchor at this point! Afterwards, the same deep silence as before, and often a silence directed at herself; she closes her eyes to herself. Young women try very hard to appear superficial and thoughtless; the most refined among them simulate a kind of impertinence. Women easily experience their men as a question-mark regarding their honour and their children as an apology or atonement — they need children and wish for them in an altogether different way from that in which a man wishes for children. In sum, one cannot be too gentle towards women! 72 Mothers. ~ Animals think differently about females than

humans do; they consider the female to be the productive being. There is no paternal love among them, only something like love for the children of a beloved and a getting used to them. In their children females have a satisfaction of their desire to dominate, a possession, an occupation, something that is totally intelligible to them and can be prattled with: all this taken together is motherly love — it is to be compared to the love of an artist for his work. Pregnancy has made women gentler, more patient, more timid, more pleased to submit; and just so does spiritual pregnancy produce the character of the contemplative type, to which 75 The Gay Science the female character is related: these are male mothers. - Among animals the male sex is considered the beautiful one. 73 Holy cruelty. — A man holding a newborn in his hand approached a holy man. ‘What should I do with this child?’ he asked; ‘it is wretched, misshapen, and doesn’t have life enough to die’. ‘Kill it!’ shouted the holy man with a terrible voice; ‘kill it and hold it in your arms for three days and three nights to create a memory for yourself: thus you will never again beget a child when it is not time for you to beget’. When the man had heard this, he walked away disappointed; and many people reproached the holy man because he had advised a cruelty; for he had advised killing the child. ‘But is it not crueller to let it live?’ said the holy man. 74 The unsuccessful. - Those poor women are always unsuccessful who, in the presence of the one they love, become restless and insecure and talk too much: for men are most surely seduced by a certain secret and phlegmatic tenderness. 75 The third sex. - ‘A small man is a paradox, but still a man; but small women seem to me, when compared to tall women, to belong to another sex’, said an old dancing master. A small woman is never beautiful — said old Aristotle.” 76 The greatest danger. — Had there not always been a majority of men who felt the discipline of their heads — their ‘rationality’ — to be their pride, their obligation, their virtue, and who were embarrassed or ashamed by all fantasizing and debauchery of thought, being the friends of ‘healthy common sense’, humanity would have perished long ago! The greatest 7 Aristotle doesn’t actually say exactly this, but see his *Nichomachean Ethics* 1123b.6—8 and *Rhetoric* 13614. 6~7. 76 Book Two danger that hovered and still hovers over humanity is the outbreak of madness — that is, the outbreak of arbitrariness in feeling, seeing, and hearing; the enjoyment in the lack of discipline of the head, the joy in human unreason. The opposite of the world of the madman is not truth and certainty but the generality and universal bindingness of a faith; in short, the non-arbitrary in judgement. And man’s greatest labour so far has been to reach agreement about very many things and to lay down a law of agreement — regardless of whether these things are true or false. This is the discipline of the head which has preserved humanity — but the counter-drives are still so powerful that it is basically with little confidence that one may speak of the future of humanity. The picture of things still moves and shifts continually, and perhaps more and faster

from now on than ever before; continually, the most select minds bristle at this universal bindingness — the explorers of truth above all! Continually this faith, as a commonplace belief shared by everyone, breeds nausea and a new lust in subtler minds; and the slow tempo for all spiritual processes which this faith makes necessary, this imitation of the tortoise that is recognized as the norm here, would by itself be sufficient to turn artists and poets into deserters: it is these impatient minds in whom a veritable delight in madness breaks out, because madness has such a cheerful tempo! What is needed, then, are virtuous intellects — oh, I'll use the most unambiguous word ~ what is needed is virtuous stupidity; what is needed are unwavering beat-keepers of the s/o w spirit, so that the believers of the great common faith stay together and go on dancing their dance: it is an exigency of the first order which commands and demands. We others are the exception and the danger — we stand eternally in need of defence! — Now there is certainly something to be said for the exception, provided it never wants to become the rule. 77 The animal with a good conscience. - The vulgar element in everything that pleases in Southern Europe — be it Italian opera (e.g. Rossini and Bellini)® or the Spanish adventure novel (most readily accessible to us in 8 Gioachino Rossini (1792— 1868) wrote thirty-six operas in the years between 1810 and 1829, then retired, devoting the remaining forty years of his life to culinary pleasures in Paris. Vincenzo Bellini's (1801—35) most famous opera is Norma. The music of Rossini and Bellini was very highly regarded by Arthur Schopenhauer (1788~1860), the modern philosopher who influenced the young Nietzsche most deeply. 77 The Gay Science the French disguise of Gil Blas)? — does not escape me; but it does not offend me, just as little as does the vulgarity that one encounters on a walk through Pompeii and basically even when reading any ancient book.!® Why is this? Is it because there is no shame and everything vulgar acts as confidently and self-assuredly as anything noble, lovely, and passionate in the same kind of music or novel? “The animal has its own right, just like the human being; let it run about freely — and you too, my dear fellow man, are still an animal despite everything!” — That seems to me to be the moral of the story and the peculiarity of Southern humanity. Bad taste has its right just as good taste does — and even a prior right if it answers to a great need, provides guaranteed satisfaction and as it were a universal language, an unconditionally intelligible mask and gesture; good, refined taste, on the contrary, is always somewhat searching, deliberate, not altogether sure how it is to be understood: it is not and never was popular! What is and remains popular is the mask! So let them all continue to go their way, all those masklike elements in the melodies and cadenzas, in the leaps and gaieties of the rhythm of these operas! Ancient life, too! What can one understand about it when one does not understand the delight in the mask, the good conscience in everything mask-like! Here is the bath and the recreation of the ancient spirit —

and maybe the rare and sublime natures of the old world needed this bath more than the vulgar. A vulgar turn in Northern works, for example in German music, on the other hand, offends me unspeakably. Here there is shame; the artist has lowered himself in his own eyes and could not even help blushing: we are ashamed with him and are so offended because we suspect that he believed he had to lower himself for our sakes. 78 What we should be grateful for. — Only artists, and especially those of the theatre, have given men eyes and ears to see and hear with some pleasure what each himself is, himself experiences, himself wants; only they have ° *Histoire de Gil Blas de Santillane* (4 vols., 1715-35) by Alain-René Lesage is one of the original picaresque novels. 10 The Roman city of Pompeii, near present-day Naples, was preserved by being covered in ash by an eruption of the volcano Vesuvius in AD 79. Excavation of the site began in the mid-nineteenth century. Nietzsche visited Naples and its environs several times. The ‘vulgarity’ of which he speaks is probably the prominent display of a variety of forms of erotic art. 78 Book Two taught us to value the hero that is hidden in each of these everyday characters and taught the art of regarding oneself as a hero, from a distance and as it were simplified and transfigured — the art of ‘putting oneself on stage’ before oneself. Only thus can we get over certain lowly details in ourselves. Without this art we would be nothing but fore-ground, and would live entirely under the spell of that perspective which makes the nearest and most vulgar appear tremendously big and as reality itself. Maybe there is a similar sort of merit in that religion which bade one to see the sinfulness of every individual through a magnifying glass and turned the sinner into a great, immortal criminal: by describing eternal perspectives around him, it taught man to view himself from a distance and as something past and whole. 79 The attraction of imperfection. — 1 see here a poet who, like some people, exerts a greater attraction through his imperfections than through all that reaches completion and perfection under his hand — indeed, his advantage and fame are due much more to his ultimate incapacity than to his ample strength. His work never wholly expresses what he really would like to express, what he would like to have seen: it seems as if he has had the foretaste of a vision, but never the vision itself — yet a tremendous lust for this vision remains in his soul, and it is from this that he derives his equally tremendous eloquence of desire and craving. With it he lifts his listener above his work and all ‘works’ and lends him wings to rise to heights which listeners otherwise never reach; and so, having themselves become poets and seers, they give the creator of their happiness their due admiration, as if he had led them immediately to the vision of what was for him holiest and most ultimate; as if he had really attained his goal and really seen and communicated his vision. The fact that he never reached his goal benefits his fame. 80 Art and nature. — The Greeks (or at least the Athenians) liked to hear good speech; indeed, they had a greedy craving for it which distinguishes them

more than anything else from the non-Greeks. And so they demanded even of passion on stage that it speak well, and 79 The Gay Science submitted with delight to the unnaturalness of dramatic verse — after all, in nature, passion is so taciturn! So mute and bashful! Or when it finds words, so confused and irrational and a shame to itself! Now thanks to the Greeks, we have all grown accustomed to this unnaturalness on stage, just as we endure and gladly endure that other unnaturalness, singing passion, thanks to the Italians. We have developed a need that we cannot satisfy in reality: to hear people in the most difficult situations speak well and at length; it delights us now when the tragic hero still finds words, reasons, eloquent gestures, and altogether a radiant spirit where life approaches the abyss and a real human being would usually lose his head and certainly his fine language. This kind of deviation from nature is perhaps the most pleasant meal for human pride; for its sake man loves art as the expression of a lofty, heroic unnaturalness and convention. We rightly reproach a dramatic poet if he does not transform everything into reason and words but always retains in his hand a residue of silence ~ just as one is dissatisfied with the musician at the opera who cannot find a melody for the highest affect but only a sentimental ‘natural’ stammering and screaming. For here nature is supposed to be contradicted! Here the vulgar charm of illusion is supposed to give way to a higher charm! The Greeks go far, far on this road — terrifyingly far! Just as they make the stage as narrow as possible and forbid themselves all effects through deep backgrounds; just as they make facial expressions and easy movement impossible for the actor and transform him into a solemn, stiff, masked puppet, so they also have deprived passion itself of any deep background and dictated to it a law of beautiful speech; yes, on the whole they have done everything to counteract the elemental effect of images that arouse fear and compassion - for fear and compassion were precisely what they did not want. With all due respect to Aristotle, he certainly didn’t hit the nail, let alone on the head, when he discussed the final purpose of Greek tragedy!! Just consider the Greek tragic poets and what most stimulated their industriousness, their sensitivity, their competitiveness — certainly not the aim of overwhelming the spectator with emotions. The Athenian went to the theatre to hear pleasing speech! Pleasing speeches were what preoccupied Sophocles!* — pardon the heresy! It is quite different with 1 Tn his Poetics (chapter 6, 1449b.24ff.) Aristotle says that tragedy has its effect by producing ‘pity /compassion’ and ‘fear’ in the audience. 12 Athenian dramatist of the fifth century BC 80 Book Two serious opera. All of its masters try to keep the audience from understanding the characters. Occasionally catching a word might help the inattentive listener, but on the whole the situation must explain itself — the speeches don’t matter! This is how they all think and have pulled their pranks with words. Maybe they only lacked the courage to express fully their ultimate disregard for words: with just a little

more impu- dence, Rossini!/? would have had everyone sing nothing but la-la-la-la — and that would have made good sense. One shouldn't believe the words of characters in opera, but rather their sound! That is the difference, that is the beautiful wnaturalness for the sake of which one goes to the opera. Even the recitativo secco* is not really meant to be heard as word and text: this kind of half-music is rather supposed initially to give the musical ear a short rest (rest from the melody as the most sublime and therefore also the most challenging pleasure of this art) — but very soon also something else, namely, a growing impatience, a growing aversion, a new desire for whole music, for melody. How are things with Richard Wagner's art,!> considered from this perspective? Is it the same, perhaps? Perhaps different? Often it has seemed to me as if one had to memorize the words and music of his creations before the performance, for otherwise -- so it appeared to me — one would hear neither the words nor even the music. 81 Greek taste. — 'What is beautiful about that?' said the surveyor after a performance of Iphigenia. 'Nothing is proved in it!'

!® Were the Greeks 13 See above, Book 11 footnote 8, p. 77. In Opera and Drama Wagner claims that Rossini had reduced opera to absolute melody, destroying its dramatic content and so opera itself. 'dry recitative'. 'Recitative' is a style of composing vocal music that tries to keep the musical form as close as possible to the cadences of normal speech. 'Dry' recitative is one in which the musical texture is sparse and the voice or voices are accompanied only by a minimal number of instruments (e.g. keyboard and violoncello). Richard Wagner (1813-83) in his theoretical writings returned again and again to the question of the proper relation between words and music in opera. Nietzsche takes this anecdote from Schopenhauer's *World as Will and Representation* (vol. 1, Book 3, § 36) where it is used to illustrate the complete discrepancy between, on the one hand, the kind of intelligence used in everyday experience, science, and mathematics (ability, according to Schopenhauer, to subsume things under the 'principle of sufficient reason') and, on the other, aesthetic contemplation. The Iphigenia in question is the play by the French dramatist Jean Racine (1639-99). 14 wm on 81 The Gay Science that far away from this taste? In Sophocles, at least, 'everything is proved'. 82 Esprit" as un-Greek. — The Greeks are indescribably logical and simple in all their thought; at least in their long good age they never wearied of this, as so often do the French, who all too gladly take a little leap into the opposite and actually only endure the spirit of logic when, through a series of such small leaps into the opposite, it betrays its sociable civility, its sociable self-denial. Logic strikes them as necessary, like bread and water, but also, like these, as a kind of prisoners' food as soon as it is enjoyed pure and plain. In good company one must never want to be entirely and solely right, which is what all pure logic wants; hence the small dose of unreason in all French esprit, The Greeks' sense of sociability was far less developed than that of the French is and

was; that is why there is so little esprit in even their most spirited men; that is why there is so little humour in even their humorists; that is why — oh! One will not even believe these sentences of mine, and how many more of the same sort are yet on my mind! — *Est res magna tacere!*[®] — says Martial along with all garrulous people. 83 Translations. — One can estimate the degree of an age's historical sense from the way it makes translations and seeks to absorb past ages and books. The French of Corneille's age!" as well as those of the Revolution seized Roman antiquity in a way we no longer dare to — thanks to our higher historical sense. And Roman antiquity itself; how violently and yet naively it laid its hand on everything good and lofty in the older Greek antiquity! How they translated things into the Roman present! How deliberately and insouciantly they brushed the dust off the wings of that butterfly called 'The-Twinkling-of-an-Eye'! In this way Horace '7 'Spirit'; the word often refers to a lively imagination. 18 'It is a great thing to keep silent' (Martial 1v.80.6). Martial was a Roman epigrammatist who lived in the first century Ab. 9 French dramatist (1606~84) who wrote a number of tragedies on ancient subjects 82 Book Two translated Alcaeus or Archilochus"? now and then, as did Propertius with Callimachus and Philetas (poets of the same rank as Theocritus,"! if we may judge): what did they care that the real creator had experienced this and that and written the signs of it into his poem! As poets they were averse to the antiquarian inquisitiveness that precedes the sense for history; as poets, they did not accept these utterly personal things and names and all those things that serve as the mask and costume of a city, coast, century. Rather they quickly replaced them with what was contemporary and Roman. They seem to ask us: 'Should we not make new for ourselves what is old and put ourselves into it? Should we not be allowed to breathe our soul into their dead body? For it is dead, after all: how ugly everything dead is!' They did not know the pleasure of a sense for history; what was past and alien was embarrassing to them; and as Romans, they saw it as an incentive for a Roman conquest. In fact at that time one conquered by translating — not merely by leaving out the historical, but also by adding allusions to the present and, above all, crossing out the name of the poet and replacing it with one's own — not with any sense of theft but with the very best conscience of the *imperium Romanum*." 84 On the origin of poetry. ~ The lovers of what is fantastic in humans, who also advocate the view that morality is instinctive, reason as follows: 'Supposing that usefulness has always been venerated as the supreme deity, then where in all the world does poetry come from? This act of making speech rhythm counteracts rather than contributes to the clarity of communication, and yet it has shot up and is still shooting up all over the earth like a mockery of all useful expediency! The wildly beautiful irrationality of poetry refutes you, you utilitarians! Precisely to want to get away from usefulness for once — that is what has elevated humanity; that is what has

inspired it to morality and art!’ Now, in this case I must 20 Archilochus (seventh century BC) and his slightly younger contemporary Alcaeus were early Greek poets who became models for the writing of poetry in Latin, for instance by Horace (first century BC). 21 The Roman poet Sextus Propertius (first century BC) cites the Greek poets Callimachus and Philetas (both fourth/third century BC) as models (2.34.31-~2; 3.1.1; 3-9.42~3). The Sicilian bucolic poet Theocritus (early third century BC) also revered Philetas. 22 ‘Roman empire’ 83 The Gay Science side with the utilitarians for once — after all, they are so seldom right, it is pitiful! In those ancient times that called poetry into being, one really did aim at utility, and a very great utility at that; back then, when one let rhythm penetrate speech — that rhythmic force that reorganizes all the atoms of a sentence, bids one to select one’s words and gives thoughts a new colour and makes them darker, stranger, more distant: a superstitious utility, of course! Rhythm was supposed to make a human request impress the gods more deeply after it was noticed that humans remember a verse better than ordinary speech; one also thought one could make oneself audible over greater distances with the rhythmic tick-tock; the rhythmic prayer seemed to get closer to the ears of the gods. Above all, one wanted to take advantage of that elemental over- powering force that humans experience in themselves when listening to music: rhythm is a compulsion; it engenders an unconquerable desire to yield, to join in; not only the stride of the feet but also the soul itself gives in to the beat — probably also, one inferred, the souls of the gods! By means of rhythm one thus tried to compel them and to exercise a power over them: one cast poetry around them like a magical snare. There was another, stranger notion, and it may be precisely what contributed most powerfully to the origin of poetry. Among the Pythagoreans”” it appears as a philosophical doctrine and as an educa- tional contrivance; but even long before there were philosophers, one acknowledged music to have the power to discharge the emotions, to cleanse the soul, to soothe the *ferocia animi*?+ — and indeed precisely through its rhythmic quality. When one had lost the proper tension and harmony of the soul, one had to dance to the beat of the singer — that was the prescription of this healing art. With it, Terpander quelled an uprising; with it, Empedocles pacified a lunatic; with it, Damon purged a youth who was languishing from love; with it, one also sought to appease the ferocious, vindictive gods.^{2>} One began by driving the 23 A group of philosophers centred in Southern Italy who claimed to be followers of Pythagoras (sixth century BC). They led a life of ritual purity and were especially devoted to the study of mathematics and harmonics. 24 “ferocity of the soul’ 25 This anecdote about Terpander (seventh century BC), one of the earliest Greek musicians who can be identified as a historical figure, is reported in chapter 42 of *On Music*, a short treatise (almost certainly incorrectly) attributed to Plutarch. The fifth-century (BC) Sicilian politician, philosopher, and shaman Empedocles had a keen interest

in all sorts of purgatives. Damon was a fifth-century (ac) Athenian politician and theorist of music who was particularly interested in the effects of music on the soul. Plato's discussion of this topic in Book 111 of Republic is probably 84 Book Two giddiness and exuberance of their passions to their peak, that is, one drove the madman wild, made the vindictive person drunk with lust for revenge. All orgiastic cults wanted to discharge the ferocia?[®] of some deity all at once and turn it into an orgy so that the deity would feel freer and calmer afterwards and leave man in peace. Etymologically, *melos**' means a tranquillizer, not because it is itself tranquil, but because its effect makes one tranquil. And not only in the cult song, but also in the mundane song of the most ancient times there is the presumption that rhythmic quality exercises a magical force; when bailing water, for instance, or rowing, the song is a bewitchment of the demons believed to be at work here; it makes them compliant, unfree, and a tool of humans. And whenever one acts, one has an occasion to sing — every action is tied to the assistance of spirits: incantation and conjuration seem to be the primordial form of poetry. When verse was used in oracles ~ the Greeks said that the hexameter was invented at Delphi — rhythm was also supposed to exercise a compulsion.”* To ask for a prophecy — that meant originally (according to the derivation of the Greek word that seems most probable to me) to have something determined: one thought one could force the future by gaining Apollo's favour ~ he who according to the oldest views is much more than a god of foresight. The way the formula is pronounced, with literal and rhythmic precision, is how it binds the future; the formula, however, is the invention of Apollo, who as god of rhythm can also bind the goddesses of fate. In short: was there anything more wsefu/ than rhythm to the old superstitious type of human being? One could do everything with it: promote some work magically; compel a god to appear, to be near, to listen; mould the future according to one's own will; discharge some excess (of fear, of mania, of pity, of vengefulness) from one's soul, and not only one's own soul but also that of the most evil demon. Without verse one was nothing; through verse one almost became a god. Such a basic feeling cannot be completely eradicated — and still today, after millennia of work at fighting such superstition, even the wisest of us occasionally becomes a fool for rhythm, if only insofar as he feels a influenced by his views, and Plato actually mentions him at 400B. This anecdote is recounted in Martianus Capella (probably fifth century ab), *De nuptis Philologiae et Mercuri* 1x.926. 26 ‘ferocity’ 27 ‘musical phrase, tune, melody’. It is unclear on what Nietzsche is basing this etymological speculation. 28 Pausanias X.5.7 85 The Gay Science thought to be truer when it has a metric form and presents itself with a divine hop, skip, and jump. Is it not amusing that the most serious philosophers, strict as they otherwise are in all matters of certainty, still appeal to the sayings of poets to lend their thoughts force and credibility? And yet it is more dangerous for a truth when a poet agrees

with it than when he contradicts it! For as Homer says: “The bards tell many a lie’.”? 85 The good and the beautiful. — Artists constantly glorify — they do nothing else — and in particular all those states and things reputed to give man the occasion for once to feel good, or great, or drunk, or merry, or well and wise. These select things and states, whose value for human happiness is considered certain and well-defined, are the artists’ objects: artists always lie in wait to discover such things and to draw them into the realm of art. I want to say: they are not themselves the appraisers of happiness and of the happy man, but they always crowd around these appraisers with the greatest curiosity and the urge to make immediate use of their appraisals. They become like this because in addition to their impatience they also have the big lungs of heralds and the feet of runners, and are always among the first to glorify the new good, and often appear to be the first to name it good and to appraise it as good. This, however, as I already said, is a mistake: they are only quicker and louder than the real appraisers. — But who are the real appraisers? ~ The rich and the idle. 86 On theatre. — This day I had strong and elevated feelings again, and if on its eve I could have music and art, I know very well what music and art I would not like to have, namely, the kind that tries to intoxicate its audience and drive it to the height of a moment of strong and elevated feelings — an art for those everyday souls who in the evening look not like victors on triumphal chariots but rather like tired mules who have been whipped somewhat too often by life. What would those people know of ‘higher moods’ were there no intoxicating substances and 29 Not actually to be found in Homer, but a proverbial Greek saying. See Aristotle, *Metaphysics* 983a.3 and Solon, Fragment 21 (Diels). 86 Book Two whip-lashes of ideals! — and so they have their inspirers as they have their wines. But what is their drink and their drunkenness to me! What is wine to the inspired! He looks instead with a sort of disgust at the means and the mediators that are supposed to produce an effect without sufficient reason — aping the high tide of the soul! What? One gives the mole wings and proud conceits — before bedtime, before he crawls into his hole? One sends him to the theatre and puts big glasses before his blind and tired eyes? People whose lives are not a ‘dramatic action’ but a business sit before the stage and look at strange creatures for whom life is more than a business? ‘It’s proper that way’, you say; ‘it’s entertaining that way; it’s culture!’ Well then! In that case I all too often lack culture, for this sight is all too often disgusting to me. Whoever has enough tragedy and comedy in himself probably does best to stay away from the theatre; or, should there be an exception, the entire event — including theatre and audience and poet — becomes the actual tragic and comic spectacle to him, so that the piece that is performed means little to him by comparison. What do the Fausts and Manfreds*° of the theatre matter to someone who is himself somewhat like Faust and Manfred? — whereas the fact that such figures are

brought on stage is certainly something for him to think about. The strongest thoughts and passions are there presented before those who are capable not of thought and passion — but of intoxication! And the former as a means to the latter! And theatre and music as the hashish-smoking and betel-chewing of the European! Oh, who will tell us the entire history of narcotics? - It is nearly the history of ‘culture’, our so-called higher culture! 87 On the vanity of artists. — \ believe that artists often do not know what they can do best because they are too vain and have set their minds on something prouder than these small plants seem to be that are new, strange, and beautiful and really capable of growing to perfection on their soil. That which in the last instance is good in their own garden and vineyard is not fully appreciated by them, and their love and insight are not of the same order. Here is a musician who, more than any other musician, is master at finding the tones from the realm of suffering, 30 In Byron’s tragedy *Manfred* (1817) the hero is burdened with excessive knowledge and tries in vain to attain forgetfulness. 87 The *Gay Science* dejected, tormented souls and at giving speech even to the mute animals. Nobody equals him at the colours of late autumn, at the indescribably moving happiness of a last, very last, very briefest enjoyment; he knows a tone for those secret, uncanny midnights of the soul, where cause and effect seem to have gone awry and something can come to be ‘from nothing’ at any moment; more happily than anyone else, he draws from the very bottom of human happiness and so to speak from its drained cup, where the most bitter and repulsive drops have merged, for better or for worse, with the sweetest ones; he knows how the soul wearily drags itself along when it can no longer leap and fly, nor even walk; he has the shy glance of concealed pain, of understanding without solace, of taking farewell without confession; yes, as the *Orpheus*! of all secret misery he is greater than anyone, and he has incorporated into art some things that seemed inexpressible and even unworthy of art, and which could only be scared away and not be grasped by words in particular — some very small and microscopic features of the soul: yes, he is master at the very small. But he doesn’t want to be! His character likes great walls and bold frescoes much better! It escapes him that his spirit has a different taste and disposition and likes best of all to sit quietly in the corners of collapsed houses — there, hidden, hidden from himself, he paints his real masterpieces, which are all very short, often only a bar long — only there does he become wholly good, great, and perfect; perhaps only there. — But he doesn’t know it! He is too vain to know it. 88 Being serious about truth. — Being serious about truth! How differently people understand these words! The very same opinions and types of proof and scrutiny that a thinker may consider a frivolity in himself to which he has, to his shame, succumbed on this or that occasion — these very same views may give an artist who encounters them and lives with them for a while the feeling that he has now become deeply serious about truth and that it is

admirable that he, as an artist, has at the same time the most serious desire for the opposite of appearance. So it can happen that it is precisely with his ardent seriousness that someone 31 The legendary Orpheus was supposed to be able to do extraordinary things, such as bringing his wife back to life from the dead, through the power of his music. 88 Book Two betrays how shallow and undemanding his mind has been in playing the field of knowledge so far. — And does not everything that we take to be important betray us? It shows us what sort of thing has weight for us and for what sort of thing we have no weights. 89 Now and formerly. — What do all our art of artworks matter if we lose that higher art, the art of festivals! Formerly, all artworks were displayed on the great festival road of humanity, as commemorations and memor- ials of high and happy moments. Now one uses artworks to lure poor, exhausted, and sick human beings to the side of humanity's road of suffering for a short lascivious moment; one offers them a little intoxication and madness. go Lights and shadows. — Books and drafts mean different things to different thinkers: one has collected in a book the lights that he was able swiftly to steal and carry home from the rays of some insight that dawned on him; another is able to convey only the shadows, the after-images in grey and black, of that which built itself up in his soul the day before. gi Caution. — As is well known, Alfieri*? lied very much when he told his amazed contemporaries his life story. He lied from that despotism against himself which he also revealed in the way he created his own language and tyrannized himself into becoming a poet — he had finally found a severe form of sublimity into which he pressed his life and his memory: no doubt there was much agony in all this. — I also would not believe a life story of Plato, written by himself — any more than that of Rousseau or *the vita nuova** of Dante. 32 an important Italian dramatist (1749-1803) 33 In addition to his political writings (e.g. *The Social Contract*) Jean-Jacques Rousseau (1712-78) wrote an important autobiography, the *Confessions* (1781). 34 *Vita Nuova* ('New Life') is a collection of Dante Alighieri's (1265~1321) poems connected by prose commentaries of a semi-autobiographical kind. 89 *The Gay Science* g Prose and poetry. — It is remarkable that the great masters of prose have almost always also been poets, be it publicly or only in secret, in the 'closet'; and verily, one writes good prose only face to face with poetry! For this is an uninterrupted, courteous war with poetry: all its attrac- tions depend on the fact that poetry is constantly evaded and contra- dicted; everything abstract wants to be presented as a prank against poetry and as if with a mocking voice; everything dry and cool is supposed to drive the lovely goddess into lovely despair; often there are rapprochements, reconciliations for a moment, and then a sudden leap back and derisive laugh; often the curtain is raised and a harsh light is let in just as the goddess is enjoying her dusks and muted colours; often the word is taken out of her mouth and sung according to a melody that makes her cover her refined ears

with her refined hands ~ and so there are a thousand delights of this war, including defeat, of which the unpoetic, the so-called men of prose, know nothing at all ~ which is why they write and speak only bad prose! War is the father of all good things;*> war is also the father of good prose! In this century, four very strange and truly poetic persons attained a mastery of prose, for which this century is otherwise not made — out of a lack of poetry, as I have suggested. Excluding Goethe, who may fairly be claimed by the century that produced him, I see Giacomo Leopardi, Prosper Mérimée, Ralph Waldo Emerson, and Walter Savage Landor, the author of *Imaginary Conversations*,*® as worthy of being called masters of prose. 93 But then why do you write? - A: I am not one of those who thing with a wet quill in hand; much less one of those who abandon themselves to their passions right before the open inkwell, sitting on their chair and staring at the paper. I am annoyed or ashamed by all writing; to me, 35 Variant of the famous saying by the pre-Socratic philosopher Heraclitus of Ephesus (late sixth century BC): ‘War is the father of all things.’ This is number 53 in the standard collections (Diels-Kranz). 36 Giacomo Leopardi (1798-1837); Italian lyric poet, also admired for his prose writings, notably *Operette Morali* (1827). The French writer Prosper Mérimée (1803-70) is now perhaps best known as the author of a ‘Carmen’ on which the libretto of the opera of that name by Bizet is based. Ralph Waldo Emerson (1803-82) was an American ‘Transcendentalist’ writer highly regarded by Nietzsche. Walter Savage Landor (1775~1864) was an English prose writer. go Book Two writing is nature’s call — to speak of it even in simile is repugnant to me. B: But why, then, do you write? — A: Well, my friend, I say this in confidence: until now I have found no other means of getting rid of my thoughts. — B: And why do you want to get rid of them? — A: Why do I want to? Do I want to? I have to. - B: Enough! Enough! 94 Growth after death. - Those audacious little words about moral matters that Fontenelle threw out in his immortal *Dialogues of the Dead**” were considered in his time to be paradoxes and games of a not wholly innocent wit; even the highest judges of taste and of the mind saw nothing more in it ~ indeed, maybe not even Fontenelle himself. Now something incredible transpires: these thoughts become truths! Science proves them! The game gets serious! And we read these dialogues with a different feeling than Voltaire® and *Helvétius*? read them, and involuntarily we promote their creators to a different and much higher rank of mind than they did. Rightly? Wrongly? 95 Chamfort.*° — That someone who knew humanity and the masses as well as Chamfort still joined the masses and did not stand aside in philosophical renunciation and defence, I can only explain as follows: one instinct in him was stronger than his wisdom and was never satisfied: his hatred of all nobility of blood; perhaps his mother’s old hatred, which was only too easy to explain and which he had sanctified through love of his mother — an instinct for revenge harking back to his boyhood,

waiting for the hour to avenge his mother. And now his life and his genius — and alas! no doubt mostly the paternal blood in his veins — had seduced him to join the ranks of this nobility as an equal, for many, many years! But eventually he could no longer stand the sight of 37 See above, Book I, footnote 3, p. 31. 38 See above, Book I, footnote 27, p. 55. 39 French Encyclopedist who defended a form of hedonistic materialism in his major work *On the Spirit* (1758) 4 French politician and writer (1741~94). Nietzsche's source for most of the material in this section is *Histoire de Chamfort, sa vie et ses euvres* by P.~J. Stahl (Paris, no date of publication given), a book which Nietzsche had in his library. gI The Gay Science himself, the sight of the 'old type of man' under the old regime; he was gripped with a violent passion of repentance which led him to put on the clothes of the mob, as Ais kind of hairshirt! His bad conscience was his failure to take revenge. If Chamfort had remained just a little bit more a philosopher, the Revolution would not have had its tragic wit and sharpest sting: it would be considered a much stupider event and would not seduce so many minds. But Chamfort's hatred and revenge educated a whole generation, and the most illustrious human beings passed through this school. Note that Mirabeau*! looked up to Cham- fort as to his higher and older self from which he expected and endured impulses, warnings, and verdicts — Mirabeau, who as a human being belongs to a quite different order of greatness than even the foremost statesmen of yesterday and today. It is peculiar that despite such a friend and advocate — after all, we have Mirabeau's letters to Chamfort — this wittiest of all moralists has remained a stranger to the French, no less than Stendhal,*" who has perhaps had the most thoughtful eyes and ears of all Frenchmen of €his century. Is it that the latter basically had too much of the Dutchman or Englishman within himself to be tolerable to the Parisians? Whereas Chamfort, a man who was rich in depths and backgrounds of the soul — gloomy, suffering, ardent ~ a thinker who found laughter necessary as a remedy against life and who nearly considered himself lost on those days when he had not laughed — seems much more like an Italian, related to Dante and Leopardi, than a Frenchman! We know Chamfort's last words: 'Ah! mon ami', he said to Sieyès, 'je m'en vais enfin de ce monde, ou il faut que le coeur se brise ou se bronze —'. Those are surely not the words of a dying Frenchman. 96 Two speakers. — Of these two speakers, the one can show the full rationality of his cause only when he abandons himself to passion: this 41 An important political figure in the early stages of the French Revolution, admired by Nietzsche: see *The Genealogy of Morality* 1.10. 42 French novelist (1783-1842). He was born Marie Henri Beyle, 'Stendhal' being a pseudonym. #8 French politician and theorist whose *What is the Third Estate?* (1789) had great influence on the early course of the French Revolution. + 'Ah, my friend, I am finally about to leave this world in which the heart must either break or plate itself with steel.' g Book Two alone pumps

enough blood and heat into his brain to force his lofty intellect to reveal itself. The other attempts the same thing now and then — to present his cause with the help of passion, sonorously, violently, and captivatively — but usually with little success. He then quite soon starts speaking obscurely and confusedly; he exaggerates, makes omissions, and arouses mistrust about the rationality of his cause; indeed, he himself comes to feel this mistrust, and this explains sudden leaps into the coldest and most repugnant tones which make the audience doubt whether his whole passion was genuine. In his case, passion inundates the mind every time — maybe because it is stronger than in the first speaker. But he is at the peak of his strength when he resists the pressing storm of his feeling and virtually derides it: only then does his mind completely step out of its hiding place — a logical, mocking, playful, and yet terrifying mind. 97 On the garrulousness of writers. - There is a garrulousness of rage — frequent in Luther, also in Schopenhauer. A garrulousness due to an exceedingly large supply of conceptual formulations, as in Kant. A garrulousness due to a delight in ever-new twists of the same thing: one finds this in Montaigne. A garrulousness of spiteful natures: whoever reads the publications of our time will recall two writers here. A garrulousness from a delight in good words and forms of language: not rare in Goethe's prose. A garrulousness from an inner pleasure in noise and confusion of feelings: for example in Carlyle. 98 In praise of Shakespeare. - The most beautiful thing I can say in praise of Shakespeare as a human being is this: he believed in Brutus and didn't cast a speck of suspicion on this type of virtue! To him he devoted his best tragedy — it is still called by the wrong name*® — to him and to the most dreadful epitome of lofty morality. Independence of soul! That's what's at stake here! No sacrifice can be too great for that: one has to be capable of sacrificing even one's dearest friend for it, even if he should 4 British writer on history and politics (1795~ 1881). 46 Shakespeare's *The Tragedy of Julius Caesar* 93 *The Gay Science* be the most marvellous human being, the ornament of the world, the genius without peer — if one loves freedom as the freedom of great souls and this freedom is endangered because of him: that is what Shakespeare must have felt! The height at which he places Caesar is the finest honour he could bestow on Brutus: only thus does he raise Brutus' inner problem to immense proportions as well as the strength of mind that was able to cut this knot! And was it really political freedom that drove this poet to sympathize with Brutus — and turned him into Brutus' accomplice? Or was political freedom only a symbolism for something inexpressible? Could it be that we confront some unknown dark event and adventure from the poet's own soul about which he wanted to speak only in signs? What is all of Hamlet's melancholy compared to that of Brutus! And perhaps Shakespeare knew the latter as he knew the former — through first-hand experience! Maybe he also had his dark hour and his evil angel, like Brutus! But whatever such similarities and

secret references there may have been: before the whole figure and virtue of Brutus, Shakespeare threw himself to the ground and felt unworthy and distant — he wrote the evidence for this into his tragedy. Twice in the tragedy he introduced a poet,*” and twice he poured such impatient and ultimate contempt upon him that it sounds like a cry — like the cry of self-contempt. Brutus, even Brutus loses patience when the poet enters — conceited, pathetic, obtrusive, as poets usually are — as a being who appears to be bursting with possibilities of greatness, even moral greatness, although in the philosophy of deed and life he rarely attains even a passable integrity. ‘When he knows his time, I’ll know his humour. / What should the wars do with these jiggling fools? / Companion, hence!’ shouts Brutus. This should be translated back into the soul of the poet who wrote it. 99 Schopenhauer’s followers. — What happens when people of a higher culture and barbarians come into contact: the lower culture usually takes on the vices, weaknesses, and excesses of the higher culture, on which basis it feels a certain attraction to that culture and finally, by way 47 Act 11, Scene 3 and Act IV, Scene 3 48 Nietzsche read and cited Shakespeare in the translation by Schlegel and Tieck. The text gives the English original. The italics are Nietzsche’s own. 94 Book Two of the acquired vices and weaknesses, accepts some overflow of the valuable force of the higher culture — one can also observe this nearby and without travelling to barbarian peoples, to be sure in a form that is somewhat over-refined and intellectualized and not so easily palpable. And what do Schopenhauer’s German followers usually take over at first from their master? In relation to his higher culture, they must feel barbarous enough to be at first barbarously fascinated and seduced by him. Is it his sense for hard facts, his good will to clarity and reason, that so often makes him appear so English and so un-German? Or is it the strength of his intellectual conscience, which endured a life-long contradiction between being and willing and forced him to contradict himself continually and on almost every point in his writings? Or is it his cleanliness in matters of the church and of the Christian god? — for here his cleanliness was unprecedented among German philosophers, so that he lived and died ‘as a Voltairean’.*? Or was it his immortal doctrine of the intellectuality of intuition, of the a priori nature of the causal law, of the instrumental nature of the intellect and the unfreedom of the will?*° No, all this does not enchant and is not felt to be enchanting; but Schopenhauer’s mystical embarrassments and evasions in those places where the factual thinker let himself be seduced and corrupted by the vain urge to be the unriddler of the world; the indemonstrable doctrine of One Will (‘all causes are merely occasional causes of the appearance of the will at this time and this place’; ‘the will to life is present wholly and undividedly in every being, even the least, as completely as in all beings that have ever been, are, and shall be, taken together’),*! the denial of the individual (‘all lions are at bottom only one lion’;

‘the plurality of individuals is an illusion’, just as development is only an illusion — he calls Lamarck’s thoughts ‘an ingenious, absurd error’),^{>*} his ecstatic reveries on genius (‘in aesthetic intuition the individual is no longer individual but pure, will-less, painless, timeless subject of knowledge’; ‘the subject, in being wholly taken up in the object it intuits, has become the object itself’),^{o*} the nonsense about compassion and how, as the * The outspoken anti-clericalism of Voltaire (see above, Book 1, footnote 27, p. 55) gave him the reputation of being an atheist. 50 See *World as Will and Representation*, vol. 1, Book 4, § 54, and vol. 11, Book 2, §§ 19, 4. 51 *Ibid.*, vol. 1, Book 4, § 60 and vol. 11, Book 2, § 25 52 *Ibid.*, vol. 1, Book 2, § 28; vol. 11, Book 3, § 38, and vol. 11, Book 4, § 41 53 French naturalist (1744~1829) who believed that acquired characteristics could be biologically inherited 54 See *World as Will and Representation*, vol. 1, Book 3, § 38. 95 The *Gay Science* source of all morality, it enables one to make the break through the principium individuationis;^{>>} and also such claims as ‘death is actually the purpose of existence’,^{oo} ‘one cannot deny a priori the possibility that a magical effect cannot also emanate from someone who has already died’ — these and other such excesses and vices of the philosopher are always what is accepted first of all and made into a matter of faith — for vices and excesses are the easiest to imitate and require no extensive preparatory practice. But let us discuss the most famous of living Schopenhauerians, Richard Wagner. What happened to him has happened to other artists: he misinterpreted the characters he created and misunderstood the philosophy that was implicit in his own art. Until the middle of his life, Richard Wagner let himself be misled by Hegel; he repeated this mistake when he started reading Schopenhauer’s doctrine into his characters and began expressing himself in terms of ‘will’, ‘genius’, and ‘compassion’. Nevertheless it will remain true that nothing goes so directly against the spirit of Schopenhauer as what is genuinely Wagnerian in Wagner’s heroes: I mean the innocence of the utmost selfishness; the faith in great passion as the good in itself, in a word, what is Siegfried-like*’ in the countenances of his heroes. ‘All of this smells even more like Spinoza than like me’, Schopenhauer might say. Although Wagner would have good reason to look for some other philosopher than Schopenhauer, the enchantment to which he succumbed with regard to this thinker has blinded him not only to other philosophers but also to science; his entire art increasingly wants to present itself as a companion piece and supplement to Schopenhauer’s philosophy, and with increasing explicitness it renounces the loftier ambition of becoming a companion piece and supplement to human knowledge and science. And not only is it the whole secretive splendour of this philosophy — which would also have attracted a Cagliostro*® — that draws him to this, but the particular gestures and affects of the philosophers were always seducers as well! Wagner is Schopenhauerian, for example, in his exasperation over the corruption of the German 5 peed ‘The

principle of individuation'. Schopenhauer believed that the reality of the universe was an undifferentiated Will which however appeared to us as a world of distinct things subject to the 'principle of individuation'. Ibid., vol. 1, Book 2, § 23, and vol. 1, Book 4, § 68 56 Ibid., vol. 11, Book 4, § 49 57 The third opera in Wagner's four-part cycle *Der Ring des Nibelungen* tells the story of the hero Siegfried, who can be taken to represent an energetic, unspoiled humanity of the future. 58 Notorious eighteenth-century charlatan 96 Book Two language;*" even, however, if one should approve of Wagner's imitation of Schopenhauer in this point, one must not conceal the fact that Wagner's style itself suffers rather seriously from all those ulcers and tumours whose sight so enraged Schopenhauer. Regarding the Wagner-ians who write German, Wagnerianism is starting to prove as dangerous as any Hegelianism ever has. Wagner is Schopenhauerian in his hatred of the Jews, to whom he is unable to do justice even in their greatest deed; after all, the Jews are the inventors of Christianity.°° Wagner is Schopenhauerian in his attempt to conceive of Christianity as a seed of Buddhism that has drifted far and to prepare a Buddhistic age for Europe, with an occasional reconciliation with Catholic-Christian formulas and sentiments.®! Wagner is Schopenhauerian when he preaches mercy in our relations with animals; as we know, Schopenhauer's predecessor in this was Voltaire, who may also, like his successors, have known to disguise his hatred of certain things and persons as mercy towards animals.®? At least Wagner's hatred of science, which finds expression in his preaching, certainly does not come from a spirit of mercy and goodness — any more, obviously, than it does from any spirit at all. In the end, the philosophy of an artist is of little significance if it is merely an afterthought (*eine nachtragliche Philosophie*) and does not harm the art itself. One cannot be too careful to avoid bearing ill will against an artist for an occasional, perhaps very unfortunate and presumptuous masquerade; let us not forget that, without exception, our dear artists are to some extent actors and have to be, and that 59 Wagner: 'Bericht an Seine Majestät den König Ludwig II. von Bayern über eine in München zu errichtende deutsche Musikschule'; Schopenhauer: 'Über Schriftstellerei und Stil' in *Parerga und Paralipomena* (vol. 11, chapter 23) 60 Wagner: *Das Judentum in der Musik* (1850); Schopenhauer: 'Zur Rechtslehre und Politik' in *Parerga und Paralipomena* (vol. 11, chapter 9, § 132) Jews should have civil rights, but it is 'absurd' to grant them rights of political participation), 'Über die Universitäts-Philosophie' in *Parerga und Paralipomena* (vol. 1) (One of the major defects of 'modern' philosophy, especially that of Hegel, is that it has imposed on itself the task of arguing for the truth of a 'Jewish mythology') etc. Wagner: *Religion und Kunst* (1880), Schopenhauer: *World as Will and Representation*, vol. 11, Book 4, § 41 Wagner, *Religion und Kunst* (1880). In Act I of *Parsifal* Gurnemanz lectures the young Parsifal on the evils of killing animals. Schopenhauer, 'Preisschrift über die

Grundlage der Moral' § 19. In this essay, as generally, Schopenhauer connects proto-animal-liberation views with anti-Semitism (see above, Book 11, footnote 60), arguing that Europeans treat animals badly because the Old Testament posits an absolute distinction between animals and humans, and claiming that anyone not 'chloroformed by the foetor Iudaicus [Jewish stench]' would see that animals and humans were essentially the same and thus should be treated with similar compassion. 66. Ru 97 The Gay Science without acting they would hardly be able to hold out very long. Let us remain faithful to Wagner in what is rue and original in him — and especially, as his disciples, by remaining faithful to ourselves in what is true and original in us. Let us leave him his intellectual tempers and cramps; let us, in all fairness, ask what strange kinds of nourishment and needs an art like his may require in order to be able to live and grow! It doesn't matter that as a thinker he is so often wrong; justice and patience are not for him. Enough that his life is justified before itself and remains justified — this life which shouts at every one of us: 'Be a man and do not follow me — but yourself! Yourself!'®? Our life, too, shall be justified before ourselves! We too shall freely and fearlessly, in innocent selfishness, grow and blossom from ourselves! And as I contemplate such a person, the following sentences still come to mind today as they did before: "That passion is better than Stoicism and hypocrisy; that being honest even in evil is better than losing oneself to the morality of tradition; that the free man can be good as well as evil, but the unfree man is a disgrace to nature and has no share in heavenly or earthly comfort; finally that everyone who wants to be free must become so through himself, and that freedom does not fall into anyone's lap as a wondrous gift' (Richard Wagner in Bayreuth, p. 94).* 100 Learning how to pay homage. — Men have to learn to pay homage just as they have to learn to feel contempt. Anyone who breaks new paths and has led many people onto new paths discovers with amazement how clumsy and poor those many are at expressing their gratitude; indeed, how seldom gratitude is able to express itself at all. It is as though whenever gratitude wants to speak, something gets caught in her throat so that she just clears her throat and falls silent clearing her throat. The way in which a thinker comes to sense the effects of his thoughts and their reorganizing and unsettling power is almost a comedy; it seems at times as if those who have been affected basically feel insulted and can ®3 Goethe's highly overwrought novel *The Sufferings of Young Werther* tells the story of a young man who is unhappy in love and shoots himself. When real young men began dressing and acting like Werther, and a few actually shot themselves, citing his example, Goethe decided he needed to intervene and had these words placed as a motto before the second edition of the text (1775). 6+ Nietzsche quotes from his own essay originally published as part of *Untimely Meditations* (1876). 98 Book Two only express what they take to be their threatened independence through a welter of incivilities. Entire generations

are needed to invent merely a polite convention for thanks; and only very late comes that time when even gratitude has acquired a kind of spirit and genius; by then, someone is usually also around to be the great recipient of the gratitude, not only for what good he himself has done, but mostly for what his predecessors have slowly heaped up as a treasure of the highest and best. IO] Voltaire.©> —

Wherever there was a court, there were laws of good speech and thus also laws of style for all who wrote. The language of the court, however, is the language of the courtier, who has no area of expertise and who forbids himself convenient technical expressions even in conversation about scientific matters because they smack of areas of expertise; that is why, in countries with a courtly culture, technical expressions and everything that betrays a specialist is considered a stylistic blemish. Now that all courts have become caricatures of past and present, one is amazed to find even Voltaire unspeakably inflexible and punctilious on this point (for example in his judgement of such stylists as Fontenelle® and Montesquieu®) — for we are all emancipated from courtly taste, while Voltaire perfected it! 102 A word to the philologists. — That there are books so valuable and regal that entire generations of scholars are well employed when, through their efforts, these books are preserved in a pure and intelligible state — philology exists to reinforce this faith again and again. It presupposes that there is no dearth of those rare human beings (even if one doesn't see them right away) who really know how to use such valuable books — probably those who themselves write or could write such books. I mean that philology presupposes a noble faith — that for the sake of a few who always 'will come' but are not there, a very great deal of painstaking, 65 See above, Book 1, footnote 27, p. 55 and Book 11, footnote 49, p. 95. 56 See above, Book 1, footnote 3, p. 31. 87 French political theorist (1689~1755) 99 The Gay Science even unclean work first needs to be done: it is all work in usum Delphinorum.© 103 On German music. - Today German music is, more than any other, the music of Europe only because it alone has given expression to the transformation that Europe underwent through the Revolution: only German composers know how to lend expression to animated masses of people; how to create that enormous artificial noise that doesn't even have to be very loud ~ whereas for example Italian opera knows only choruses of servants or soldiers, but not 'people'.©' Moreover, in all German music one can hear a deep bourgeois envy of nobility, especially of esprit and élégance as expressions of a courtly, knightly, old, self-assured society. This music is not like that of Goethe's singer before the gate, which also pleases 'in the great hall' and actually pleases the king; the idea is not "The knights looked bravely thither, and the fair down at their laps'."? Even grace (Grazie) does not appear in German music without pangs of conscience; only in the presence of native charm (Anmut), the rustic sister of grace, does the German begin to feel wholly moral — and from that

point on increasingly so, all the way up to his rapturous, erudite, often gruff ‘sublimity’, the sublimity of Beethoven. If you want to picture the human being for this music, well, just imagine Beethoven as he appears beside Goethe — say, at their encounter at Teplitz:”! as semi-barbarism beside culture, as the people beside nobility, as the good-natured human being next to the good and more than merely ‘good’ human being, as the visionary beside the artist, as 8 The eldest son of the King of France and heir apparent to the throne was called ‘the Dauphin’. In order to ensure that his son received the best education possible the French king Louis XIV had a special edition of Greek and Latin authors made ‘in usum Delphini’ (i.e. ‘for the use of the Dauphin’). This edition deleted passages from the works that were considered objectionable for one reason or another. In usum Delphinarum means ‘for the use of Dauphins’. This is an extraordinary statement, which must reflect Nietzsche’s selective view of Italian opera. In particular, the chorus of Hebrew slaves from Verdi’s *Naducco* (1842), ‘Va pensiero’, became one of the most famous patriotic songs of the Italian Risorgimento. Poem by Goethe from his novel *Wilhelm Meister*, Book 11, chapter 11. Goethe and Beethoven, walking together in the spa town of Teplitz, encountered the Empress and her entourage. The staunch republican Beethoven tried to get Goethe to follow his example of not making way for the Imperial Suite, but Goethe, who was for decades an official at the small German court of Weimar, politely stepped aside and removed his hat as the Empress passed. 69 7 7 = Ss 100 Book Two the man in need of comfort next to the man who is comforted, as the exaggerating and suspicious man next to the fair-minded, as the moody self-tormentor, the foolishly ecstatic, the blissfully unhappy, the guilelessly immoderate, as the presumptuous and crude — and all in all, the ‘untamed human being’.”* that is how Goethe himself experienced and characterized him — Goethe, the exception among Germans for whom no music of equal rank has yet been found! Consider finally whether the ever more widely reaching contempt for melody and the atrophy of the melodic sense among Germans can be understood as a democratic boorishness and after-effect of the Revolution. For melody has such an open joy in lawfulness and such a revulsion towards everything that is inchoate, unformed, and arbitrary that it sounds like a strain from the old order of things European and like a seduction and return to it. 104 On the sound of the German language. — We know where the German comes from that for a few centuries has been accepted as literary German. The Germans, with their reverence for everything that came from the court, have deliberately taken the chanceries as their model in everything they had to write, such as letters, documents, wills, and so forth. To write in the style of the chanceries was to write like the courts and the government — that was something distinguished compared to the German spoken in the city in which one happened to live. Eventually one drew the consequences and started to speak

the way one wrote — thus one became even more discriminating in word formations, in the choice of words and phrases, and finally also in sound: one affected a courtly tone when speaking, and in the end the affectation became natural. Perhaps nothing like this has happened anywhere else: the triumph of written style over speech and the affectation and pomposity of a whole people as the foundation of a common language that is no longer a mere conjunction of dialects. I believe that the sound of the German language in the middle ages, and especially in the time after the middle ages, was deeply rustic and vulgar; in the last few centuries it has become a bit more refined, primarily because one felt compelled to imitate so many French, Italian, and Spanish sounds — 7 Goethe describes Beethoven thus in a letter to the former's friend Zelter of 2 September 1812. 101 The Gay Science particularly on the part of the German (and Austrian) nobility, which could in no way be content with the mother tongue. But despite this exercise, German must have sounded unbearably vulgar to Montaigne or even Racine; and to this day, in the mouth of travellers even in the midst of an Italian rabble, it sounds very coarse and hoarse, as if it originated in the back woods in smoky cabins and rude regions. I note today that among the former admirers of the chanceries a similar yearning for refinement of sound is spreading, and that the Germans are starting to obey a most peculiar 'acoustic spell' which could, in the long run, become a real danger to the German language — for one would seek in vain to find more abhorrent sounds in Europe. Something scornful, cold, indifferent, careless in one's voice: that is what sounds 'refined' to Germans today — and I hear the good will to this refinement in the voices of young officials, teachers, women, merchants; even little girls are starting to imitate this officers' German. For the officer — specifically the Prussian officer — is the inventor of these sounds: this same officer who as military man and specialist possesses that admirable tact of modesty which all Germans could stand to learn (including German professors and musicians!). But as soon as he speaks and moves, the German officer is the most immodest and distasteful figure in old Europe — quite unselfconsciously, without any doubt! Nor are the good Germans conscious of this when they admire him as the man of the foremost and most distinguished society and gladly let him 'set the tone'. And so he does! First it is the sergeants and the non-commissioned officers who imitate and coarsen his tone. Just listen to the shouted commands that positively surround German cities with a roar now that they drill outside all the gates: what presumptuousness, what raging sense of authority, what scornful coldness reverberates from this roar! Are the Germans really supposed to be a musical people? It is certain that the Germans are becoming militarized in the sound of their language; it is probable that once they have got used to speaking in a military tone, they will eventually also start writing that way. For being used to certain sounds has a profound effect on character — one soon has the words and

phrases, and finally also the thoughts that fit this sound! Maybe the Germans already write like officers; maybe I just read too little of what is written in Germany. But one thing I know more certainly: the public German proclamations that also reach other countries are inspired not by German music but by this new sound of a 102 Book Two distasteful presumptuousness. In almost every speech of the foremost German statesman, and even when he lets himself be heard only through his imperial mouthpiece,”? is an accent that repels with revulsion the ear of a foreigner. But the Germans endure it — they endure themselves. 105 The Germans as artists. - When the German really works up a passion (and not merely the usual good will to passion!), he behaves as he must, and thinks no further about his behaviour. But the truth is that his behaviour is then very clumsy and ugly, as if lacking in tact and melody, so that the spectators merely have their own feelings of embarrassment or pathos and nothing more — unless he elevates himself into that state of sublimity and rapture, of which many passions are capable. Then even the German becomes beautiful. An idea of the height at which beauty first begins to pour its magic even over Germans drives the German artists into the heights and superheights and excesses of passion: in other words, a genuinely deep desire to rise beyond, at least look beyond, the ugliness and clumsiness — to a better, lighter, more southern, sunnier world. And so their cramps are often just indications that they would like to dance: these poor bears in which hidden nymphs and sylvan gods are at work — and at times still higher deities! 106 Music as advocate ~— ‘I am thirsting for a master composer’, said an innovator to his disciple, ‘who can learn my thoughts from me and hereafter speak them in his language: that way I will better penetrate into people’s ears and hearts. With tones one can seduce people into every error and every truth: who could refute a tone?’ — ‘So you would like to be considered irrefutable?’ said his disciple. The innovator replied: ‘I wish for the sprout to become a tree. For a teaching to become a tree, it has to be believed for a good while; for it to be believed, it has to be considered irrefutable. The tree needs storms, doubts, % This probably refers to Chancellor Bismarck (‘foremost statesman’) and Emperor Wilhelm I (‘imperial mouthpiece’). 103 The Gay Science worms, and malice in order to reveal the nature and strength of its sprout; may it break if it is not strong enough! But a sprout can only be destroyed — not refuted!’ When he had said that, his disciple cried impetuously: ‘But I believe in your cause and consider it so strong that I will say everything, everything that I still have on my mind against it’. The innovator laughed to himself and wagged a finger at him. “This kind of discipleship’, he said, ‘is the best, but it is dangerous and not every kind of teaching can withstand it’. 107 Our ultimate gratitude to art. - Had we not approved of the arts and invented this type of cult of the untrue, the insight into general untruth and mendacity that is now given to us by science — the insight into delusion and error as a condition of

cognitive and sensate existence ~ would be utterly unbearable. Honesty would lead to nausea and suicide. But now our honesty has a counterforce that helps us avoid such consequences: art, as the good will to appearance. We do not always keep our eyes from rounding off, from finishing off the poem; and then it is no longer eternal imperfection that we carry across the river of becoming — we then feel that we are carrying a goddess, and are proud and childish in performing this service. As an aesthetic phenomenon existence is still bearable to us, and art furnishes us with the eye and hand and above all the good conscience to be able to make such a phenomenon of ourselves. At times we need to have a rest from ourselves by looking at and down at ourselves and, from an artistic distance, laughing at ourselves or crying at ourselves; we have to discover the hero no less than the fool in our passion for knowledge; we must now and then be pleased about our folly in order to be able to stay pleased about our wisdom! And precisely because we are at bottom grave and serious human beings and more weights than human beings, nothing does us as much good as the fool's cap: we need it against ourselves — we need all exuberant, floating, dancing, mocking, childish, and blissful art lest we lose that freedom over things that our ideal demands of us. It would be a relapse for us, with our irritable honesty, to get completely caught up in morality and, for the sake of the overly severe demands that we there make on ourselves, to become virtuous monsters and scarecrows. We have also to be able to stand above morality 104 Book Two ~ and not just to stand with the anxious stiffness of someone who is afraid of slipping and falling at any moment, but also to float and play above it! How then could we possibly do without art and with the fool? — And as long as you are in any way ashamed of yourselves, you do not yet belong amongst us! 105 Book Three Book Three 108 New battles. — After Buddha was dead, they still showed his shadow in a cave for centuries — a tremendous, gruesome shadow. God is dead; but given the way people are, there may still for millennia be caves in which they show his shadow. — And we — we must still defeat his shadow as well! 109 Let us beware. — Let us beware of thinking that the world is a living being. Where would it stretch? What would it feed on? How could it grow and procreate? After all, we know roughly what the organic is; are we then supposed to reinterpret what is inexpressibly derivative, late, rare, accidental, which we perceive only on the crust of the earth, as something essential, common, and eternal, as those people do who call the universe an organism? This nauseates me. Let us beware even of believing that the universe is a machine; it is certainly not constructed to one end, and the word 'machine' pays it far too high an honour. Let us beware of assuming in general and everywhere anything as elegant as the cyclical movements of our neighbouring stars; even a glance at the Milky Way raises doubts whether there are not much coarser and more contradictory movements there, as well as stars with eternally linear paths, etc. The astral order in which

we live is an exception; this order and the considerable duration that is conditioned by it have again made possible the exception of exceptions: the development of the organic. The total character of the world, by contrast, is for all eternity chaos, not in the sense of a lack of necessity but of a lack of order, organization, form, beauty, wisdom, and whatever else our aesthetic anthropomorphisms are called. Judged from the vantage point of our reason, the unsuccessful attempts are by far the rule; the exceptions are not the secret aim, and the whole musical mechanism repeats eternally its tune, which must never be called a melody — and ultimately even the phrase ‘unsuccessful attempt’ is already an anthropomorphism bearing a reproach. But how could we reproach or praise the universe! Let us beware of attributing to it heartlessness or unreason or their opposites: it is neither perfect, nor beautiful, nor noble, nor does it want to become any of these things; in no way does it strive to imitate man! In no way do 109 The Gay Science our aesthetic and moral judgements apply to it! It also has no drive to self-preservation or any other drives; nor does it observe any laws. Let us beware of saying that there are laws in nature. There are only necessities: there is no one who commands, no one who obeys, no one who transgresses. Once you know that there are no purposes, you also know that there is no accident; for only against a world of purposes does the word ‘accident’ have a meaning. Let us beware of saying that death is opposed to life. The living is only a form of what is dead, and a very rare form. Let us beware of thinking that the world eternally creates new things. There are no eternally enduring substances; matter is as much of an error as the god of the Eleatics.! But when will we be done with our caution and care? When will all these shadows of god no longer darken us? When will we have completely de-deified nature? When may we begin to naturalize humanity with a pure, newly discovered, newly redeemed nature? Ilo Origin of knowledge. - Through immense periods of time, the intellect produced nothing but errors; some of them turned out to be useful and species-preserving; those who hit upon or inherited them fought their fight for themselves and their progeny with greater luck. Such erroneous articles of faith, which were passed on by inheritance further and further, and finally almost became part of the basic endowment of the species, are for example: that there are enduring things; that there are identical things; that there are things, kinds of material, bodies; that a thing is what it appears to be; that our will is free; that what is good for me is also good in and for itself. Only very late did the deniers and doubters of such propositions emerge; only very late did truth emerge as the weakest form of knowledge. It seemed that one was unable to live with it; that our organism was geared for its opposite: all its higher functions, the perceptions of sense and generally every kind of sensation, worked with those basic errors that had been incorporated since time immemorial. Further, even in the realm of knowledge those propositions became the norms according to which one

determined ‘true’ and ‘untrue’ — down to the most remote areas of pure logic. Thus 1 Group of philosophers in the early fifth century 8c who argued that the world of change was a mere appearance of an underlying unchanging being Ilo Book Three the strength of knowledge lies not in its degree of truth, but in its age, its embeddedness, its character as a condition of life. Where life and knowledge seem to contradict each other, there was never any serious fight to begin with; denial and doubt were simply considered madness. Those exceptional thinkers, like the Eleatics, who still posited and clung to the opposites of the natural errors, believed in the possibility of also living this opposite: they invented the sage as the man of unchange- ability, impersonality, universality of intuition, as one and all at the same time, with a special capacity for that inverted knowledge; they had the faith that their knowledge was at the same time the principle of /ife. But in order to be able to claim all this, they had to deceive themselves about their own state: they had fictitiously to attribute to themselves imper- sonality and duration without change; they had to misconstrue the nature of the knower, deny the force of impulses in knowledge, and generally conceive reason as a completely free, self-originated activity. They closed their eyes to the fact that they, too, had arrived at their propositions in opposition to what was considered valid or from a desire for tranquillity or sole possession or sovereignty. The subtler develop- ment of honesty and scepticism finally made also these people impos- sible; even their life and judgements proved dependent on the ancient drives and fundamental errors of all sentient existence. This subtler honesty and scepticism arose wherever two conflicting propositions seemed to be applicable to life because both were compatible with the basic errors, and thus where it was possible to argue about the greater or lesser degree of usefulness for life; also wherever new propositions showed themselves to be not directly useful, but at least also not harmful, as expressions of an intellectual play impulse, and innocent and happy like all play. Gradually the human brain filled itself with such judgements and convictions; and ferment, struggle, and lust for power developed in this tangle. Not only utility and delight, but also every kind of drive took part in the fight about the ‘truths’; the intellectual fight became an occupation, attraction, profession, duty, dignity — knowledge and the striving for the true finally took their place as a need among the other needs. Henceforth, not only faith and conviction, but also scrutiny, denial, suspicion, and contradiction were a power; all ‘evil’ instincts were subordinated to knowledge and put in its service and took on the lustre of the permitted, honoured, useful and finally the eye and the innocence of the good. Thus knowledge became a part of life and, as III The Gay Science life, a continually growing power, until finally knowledge and the ancient basic errors struck against each other, both as life, both as power, both in the same person. The thinker — that is now the being in whom the drive to truth and those life-preserving errors are fighting their first

battle, after the drive to truth has proven itself to be a life- preserving power, too. In relation to the significance of this battle, everything else is a matter of indifference: the ultimate question about the condition of life is posed here, and the first attempt is made here to answer the question through experiment. To what extent can truth stand to be incorporated? — that is the question; that is the experiment.

III The origin of the logical. ~ What is the origin of logic in man's head?

Surely it arose out of the illogical, the realm of which must originally have been immense. But innumerable beings drew inferences in a way different from that in which we do now perished; nonetheless, they might have been closer to the truth! He, for instance, who did not know how to find 'identity' often enough, both with regard to nourishment and to hostile animals ~ that is, he who subsumed too slowly and was too cautious in subsumption — had a slighter probability of survival than he who in all cases of similarity immediately guessed that they were identical. The predominant disposition, however, to treat the similar as identical — an illogical disposition, for there is nothing identical as such — is what first supplied all the foundations for logic. Similarly, in order for the concept of substance to originate, which is indispensable to logic though nothing real corresponds to it in the strictest sense, it was necessary that for a long time changes in things not be seen, not be perceived; the beings who did not see things exactly had a head start over those who saw everything 'in a flux'. As such, every great degree of caution in inferring, every sceptical disposition, is a great danger to life. No living being would be preserved had not the opposite disposition — to affirm rather than suspend judgement, to err and make things up rather than wait, to agree rather than deny, to pass judgement rather than be just — been bred to become extraordinarily strong. The course of logical thoughts and inferences in our brains today corresponds to a process and battle of drives that taken separately are all very illogical and unjust; we usually experience only the outcome

112 Book Three of the battle: that is how quickly and covertly this ancient mechanism runs its course in us.

112 Cause and effect. — We call it 'explanation', but 'description' is what distinguishes us from older stages of knowledge and science. We are better at describing — we explain just as little as all our predecessors. We have uncovered a diverse succession where the naive man and investi- gator of older cultures saw only two different things, 'cause' and 'effect', as they said; we have perfected the picture of becoming but haven't got over, got behind the picture. The series of 'causes' faces us much more completely in each case; we reason, 'this and that must precede for that to follow' — but we haven't thereby understood anything. The specifically qualitative aspect for example of every chemical process, still appears to be a 'miracle', as does every locomotion; no one has 'explained' the push. And how could we explain! We are operating only with things that do not exist — with lines, surfaces, bodies, atoms, divisible times, divisible spaces. How is

explanation to be at all possible when we first turn everything into a picture — our picture! It is enough to view science as an attempt to humanize things as faithfully as possible; we learn to describe ourselves more and more precisely as we describe things and their succession. Cause and effect: there is probably never such a duality; in truth a continuum faces us, from which we isolate a few pieces, just as we always perceive a movement only as isolated points, i.e. do not really see, but infer. The suddenness with which many effects stand out misleads us; it is a suddenness only for us. There is an infinite number of processes that elude us in this second of suddenness. An intellect that saw cause and effect as a continuum, not, as we do, as arbitrary division and dismemberment — that saw the stream of the event — would reject the concept of cause and effect and deny all determinedness. 113 On the doctrine of poisons. - So much has to come together in order for scientific thought to originate, and all these necessary forces have had to be separately invented, practised, cultivated! In their separateness they 113 The Gay Science have, however, very often had a totally different effect from that which they have today when in the realm of scientific thought they mutually limit and keep each other in check: they have worked as poisons, e.g. the doubting drive, the denying drive, the waiting drive, the collecting drive, the dissolving drive. Many hecatombs of human beings had to be sacrificed before these drives learned to grasp their coexistence and feel like functions of one organizing force in one human being! And how far we still are from the time when artistic energies and the practical wisdom of life join with scientific thought so that a higher organic system will develop in relation to which the scholar, the physician, the artist, and the lawmaker, as we now know them, would have to appear as paltry antiquities! Iq The scope of the moral. ~ As soon as we see a new picture, we immediately construct it with the help of all the old experiences we have had depending on the degree of our honesty and justice. There are no experi- ences other than moral ones, not even in the realm of sense perception. 115 The four errors. - Man has been educated by his errors: first, he saw himself only incompletely; secondly, he endowed himself with fictitious attributes; thirdly, he placed himself in a false rank order in relation to animals and nature; fourthly, he invented ever new tables of goods and for a time took them to be eternal and unconditioned — so that now this, now that human drive and condition occupied first place and was ennobled as a result of this valuation. If one discounts the effect of these four errors, one has also discounted humanity, humaneness, and 'human dignity'. 116 Herd instinct. — Wherever we encounter a morality, we find an evaluation and ranking of human drives and actions. These evaluations and rankings are always the expression of the needs of a community and herd: that which benefits it the most ~ and second most, and third most 114 Book Three — is also the highest standard of value for all individuals. With morality the individual is instructed to be a function of the herd and to ascribe

value to himself only as a function. Since the conditions for preserving one community have been very different from those of another community, there have been very different moralities; and in view of essential changes in herds and communities, states and societies that are yet to come, one can prophesy that there will yet be very divergent moralities. Morality is herd-instinct in the individual. 117 Herd pangs of conscience. — During the longest and most remote periods of time there was a kind of pang of conscience completely different from that which exists now. Today one feels responsible only for what one wants and does, and finds one's pride in oneself: all our teachers of justice start from this feeling of self and pleasure in the individual (*des Einzelnen*), as if the spring of justice (*des Rechts*) had always arisen here. But for the longest period of humanity's existence there was nothing more frightful than feeling alone (*einzel*). To be alone (*allein*), to experience things by oneself (*einzeln*), to neither obey nor rule, to represent an individual (*ein Individuum bedeuten*) — that was no pleasure back then, but a punishment; one was sentenced 'to be an individual (*Individuum*). Freedom of thought was considered discomfort itself. While we experience law and conformity as compulsion and loss, one formerly experienced egoism as a painful thing, as an actual affliction. To be a self, to estimate oneself according to one's own measure and weight — that was contrary to taste in those days. The inclination to this would have been considered madness, for every misery and every fear were associated with being alone (*Alleinsein*). Back then, 'free will' had bad conscience as its closest neighbour. The more unfreely one acted, the more the herd instinct and not the sense of self spoke through the action, the more moral one considered oneself. In those days, everything that hurt the herd, whether the individual had willed it or not, gave the individual pangs of conscience — and his neighbour as well; indeed, the whole herd! On this point we have relearned most of all. 2 The German word 'Recht' is usually ambiguous, meaning both 'right' and 'law'. In this case it seems best to render it as 'justice'. It The Gay Science 118 Benevolence. — Is it virtuous when a cell transforms itself into a function of a stronger cell? It has to. And is it evil when the stronger cell assimilates the weaker? It also has to; this is necessary for it, since it strives for superabundant replenishment and wants to regenerate itself. Accordingly one should make a distinction in benevolence between the drive to appropriate and the drive to submit, depending on whether it is the stronger or the weaker who experiences it. Joy and desire go together in the stronger, who wants to transform something into a function of himself; joy and the wish to be desired go together in the weaker, who wants to become a function. Compassion is essentially the former, a pleasant stirring of the drive to appropriate at the sight of the weaker; however, we must still keep in mind that 'strong' and 'weak' are relative concepts. 119 No altruism! — In many people I see a surplus strength and pleasure in wanting to

become a function; they press towards and have the most delicate sense for all places where precisely they can be a function. Here belong those women who turn themselves into some function of a man that is especially weakly developed in him, and to that extent become his purse or his politics or his sociability. Such beings preserve themselves best when they insert themselves into another organism; if they do not succeed at this, they become cranky, irritated, and devour themselves.

120 Health of the soul. - The popular medical formulation of morality (the originator of which is Ariston of Chios), 'virtue is the health of the soul',[?] would, in order to be useful, have to be changed at least to read, 'your virtue is the health of your soul'. For there is no health as such, and all attempts to define such a thing have failed miserably. Deciding what is health even for your body depends on your goal, your horizon, your powers, your impulses, your mistakes and above all on the ideals.

3 Ariston lived in the third century Bc. This is fragment number 359 in *Stotcorum veterum Jragmenta*, ed. von Arnim, 116 Book Three and phantasms of your soul. Thus there are innumerable healths of the body; and the more one allows the particular and incomparable to rear its head again, the more one unlearns the dogma of the 'equality of men', the more the concept of a normal health, along with those of a normal diet and normal course of an illness, must be abandoned by our medical men. Only then would it be timely to reflect on the health and illness of the sou/ and to locate the virtue peculiar to each man in its health — which of course could look in one person like the opposite of health in another. Finally, the great question would still remain whether we can do without illness, even for the development of our virtue; and whether especially our thirst for knowledge and self-knowledge do not need the sick soul as much as the healthy; in brief, whether the will to health alone is not a prejudice, a cowardice and a piece of most refined barbarism and backwardness.

121 Life not an argument. — We have arranged for ourselves a world in which we are able to live — by positing bodies, lines, planes, causes and effects, motion and rest, form and content; without these articles of faith no one could endure living! But that does not prove them. Life is not an argument; the conditions of life might include error.

122 Moral scepticism in Christianity. — Christianity, too, has made a great contribution to enlightenment: it taught moral scepticism in an extre- mely trenchant and effective way — accusing, embittering, but with untiring patience and refinement; it annihilated in every single man the faith in his 'virtues'. It caused those great virtuous men, of whom there was no dearth in antiquity, to disappear forever from the face of the earth — those popular men who with a faith in their own perfection went about with the dignity of a toreador. When we now, educated in this Christian school of scepticism, read the moral books of antiquity, e.g. those of Seneca or Epictetus,* we feel an amusing superiority and are full of secret insights and overviews, as if a child were speaking before

4+ Two stoic philosophers: Seneca (first century

AD) was a wealthy member of the Roman ruling class. Epictetus (late first/early second century) was a freed Greck slave. 117 The Gay Science an old man or an overenthusiastic young beauty were speaking before La Rochefoucauld: * we know better what virtue is! In the end, however, we have applied this same scepticism also to all religious states and procedures, such as sin, repentance, grace, sanctification; and we have all allowed the worm to dig so deeply that even when reading Christian books we now have the same feeling of refined superiority and insight: we also know the religious feelings better! And it is time to know them well and to describe them well, for even the pious of the old faith are dying out: let us save their image and their type at least for knowledge! 123 Knowledge more than a means, — Even without this new passion — I mean the passion for knowledge — science would be promoted: up to now science has grown and matured without it. The good faith in science, the prejudice in its favour that rules our modern states (and formerly even the Church), is essentially based on the fact that this unconditional tendency and urge has manifested itself in science so rarely and that science is specifically regarded not as a passion but as a condition and ‘ethos’. Indeed, often mere amour-plaisir® of knowledge (curiosity) is sufficient, or amour-vanité, being accustomed to it with the ulterior motive of honour and bread; it is even enough for many that they have a surplus of leisure and do not know what to do with it except read, collect, arrange, observe, recount — their ‘scientific drive’ is their boredom. Pope Leo X® once (in his brief to Beroaldus) sang the praise of science: he designated it the most beautiful ornament and the greatest pride of our life, a noble occupation in happiness and unhappiness; ‘without it’, he says finally, ‘all human undertakings would lack a firm hold — indeed, even with it they are changeable and unstable enough!’ But this fairly sceptical pope keeps silent, like all other churchly eulogists of science, his final judgement on science. Although one might 5 The Reflections of La Rochefoucauld (161380) contain a wealth of exceptionally astute and disillusioned observations about human action and motivation. ‘the love which is pleasure’ ‘the love which is vanity’. Nietzsche takes the distinction between amour-plaisir and amour-vanité from Stendhal (see above, Book 11, footnote 42, p. 92) who actually distinguishes four kinds of love; see his *De l’amour*, chapter 1. Originally Giovanni de’ Medici (1475~—1521), elected to the Papacy in 1513; very active patron of the arts Minor Italian humanist (1472~—1518) oo so rd 118 Book Three infer from his words that he places science above art — strange as this may be for such a friend of the arts — in the end it is nothing but politeness when he does not speak of what he, too, places high above all science: ‘revealed truth’ and the ‘eternal salvation of the soul’. Compared to that, what are ornaments, pride, entertainment, and the security of life to him! ‘Science is something second-class; nothing ultimate, unconditional; not an object of passion’ — this judgement was held back in Leo’s soul: the truly

Christian judgement about science! In antiquity the dignity and recognition of science were diminished by the fact that even among her most zealous disciples the striving for virtue took first place, and that one thought one had given knowledge one's highest praise when one celebrated it as the best means to virtue. It is something new in history that knowledge wants to be more than a means. 124 In the horizon of the infinite. - We have forsaken the land and gone to sea! We have destroyed the bridge behind us — more so, we have demolished the land behind us! Now, little ship, look out! Beside you is the ocean; it is true, it does not always roar, and at times it lies there like silk and gold and dreams of goodness. But there will be hours when you realize that it is infinite and that there is nothing more awesome than infinity. Oh, the poor bird that has felt free and now strikes against the walls of this cage! Woe, when homesickness for the land overcomes you, as if there had been more freedom there — and there is no more 'land'! 125 The madman. — Haven't you heard of that madman who in the bright morning lit a lantern and ran around the marketplace crying incessantly, 'I'm looking for God! I'm looking for God!' Since many of those who did not believe in God were standing around together just then, he caused great laughter. Has he been lost, then? asked one. Did he lose his way like a child? asked another. Or is he hiding? Is he afraid of us? Has he gone to sea? Emigrated? - Thus they shouted and laughed, one interrupting the other. The madman jumped into their midst and pierced them with his eyes. 'Where is God?' he cried; 'I'll tell you! We 11g The Gay Science have killed him — you and I! We are all his murderers. But how did we do this? How were we able to drink up the sea? Who gave us the sponge to wipe away the entire horizon? What were we doing when we unchained this earth from its sun? Where is it moving to now? Where are we moving to? Away from all suns? Are we not continually falling? And backwards, sideways, forwards, in all directions? Is there still an up and a down? Aren't we straying as though through an infinite nothing? Isn't empty space breathing at us? Hasn't it got colder? Isn't night and more night coming again and again? Don't lanterns have to be lit in the morning? Do we still hear nothing of the noise of the grave-diggers who are burying God? Do we still smell nothing of the divine decomposition? — Gods, too, decompose! God is dead! God remains dead! And we have killed him! How can we console ourselves, the murderers of all murderers! The holiest and the mightiest thing the world has ever possessed has bled to death under our knives: who will wipe this blood from us? With what water could we clean ourselves? What festivals of atonement, what holy games will we have to invent for ourselves? Is the magnitude of this deed not too great for us? Do we not ourselves have to become gods merely to appear worthy of it? There was never a greater deed — and whoever is born after us will on account of this deed belong to a higher history than all history up to now!' Here the madman fell silent and looked again at his listeners; they too were silent and

looked at him disconcertedly. Finally he threw his lantern on the ground so that it broke into pieces and went out. 'I come too early', he then said; 'my time is not yet. This tremendous event is still on its way, wandering; it has not yet reached the ears of men. Lightning and thunder need time; the light of the stars needs time; deeds need time, even after they are done, in order to be seen and heard. This deed is still more remote to them than the remotest stars — and yet they have done it themselves! It is still recounted how on the same day the madman forced his way into several churches and there started singing his requiem aeternam deo.' Led out and called to account, he is said always to have replied nothing but, 'What then are these churches now if not the tombs and sepulchres of God?' 10 'Grant God eternal rest.' A transformation of that part of the service for the dead which reads 'Requiem aeternam dona eis {scilicet, mortuis}, Domine' ('Lord, grant them [the dead] eternal rest') 120 Book Three 126

Mystical explanations — Mystical explanations are considered deep; the truth is, they are not even shallow. 127 Afieffects of the oldest religiosity. — Every thoughtless person believes that the will alone is effective; that willing is something simple, absolutely given, underivable, and intelligible in itself. When he does something, e.g. strikes something, he is convinced that it is Ae who is striking, and that he did the striking because he wanted to strike. He does not even notice a problem here; the feeling of will suffices for him to assume cause and effect, but also to believe that he understands their relation. He knows nothing of the mechanism of what happened and the hundredfold delicate work that has to be done to bring about the strike, or of the incapacity of the will as such to do even the slightest part of this work. The will is to him a force that works by magic: the belief in the will as the cause of effects is the belief in forces that work by magic. Now, originally man believed, wherever he saw something happen, that a will had to be the cause and that beings with a personal will had to be operating in the background — the concept of mechanics was quite foreign to him. But since man believed for immense periods of time only in persons (and not in substances, forces, things, etc.), the faith in cause and effect has become for him the fundamental faith that he uses everywhere something happens — still today instinctively and as an atavism of the oldest origin. The propositions, 'no effect without a cause', 'every effect again a cause', appear as generalizations of much narrower propositions: 'no effecting without willing'; 'it is possible to have an effect only on willing beings'; 'no suffering of an effect is ever pure and without consequences, but all suffering is an agitation of the will (towards action, defence, revenge, retribution) — but in the prehistory of humanity the former and latter propositions were identical: the former were not generalizations of the latter, but the latter were elucidations of the former.!! With his assumption that only that which wills exists, Schopenhauer enthroned a primordial mythology; he "See Schopenhauer, 'Über die vierfache Wurzel des Satzes vom

zureichenden Grunde' (1813). 121 The Gay Science seems never to have attempted an analysis of the will because like everyone else he believed in the simplicity and immediacy of all willing — whereas willing is actually such a well-practised mechanism that it almost escapes the observing eye. Against him I offer these propositions: first, in order for willing to come about, a representation of pleasure or displeasure is needed. Secondly, that a violent stimulus is experienced as pleasure or pain is a matter of the interpreting intellect, which, to be sure, generally works without our being conscious of it (uns unbewu/t); and one and the same stimulus can be interpreted as pleasure or pain. Thirdly, only in intellectual beings do pleasure, pain, and will exist; the vast majority of organisms has nothing like it. 128 The value of prayer. — Prayer has been invented for people who never really have thoughts of their own and who know no elevation of the soul or do not notice it if it occurs: what are such people to do in sacred places or in all important situations in life that demand calm and a kind of dignity? In order that they at least do not disturb, the wisdom of all founders of religions, small as well as great, has prescribed to them the formulas of prayer as a long mechanical work of the lips, combined with exertion of the memory and a same fixed posture of hands and feet and eyes! So they may, like the Tibetans, go ahead regurgitating their 'om mane padme hum'!* countless times or, as in Benares, count the name of the god off their fingers, Ram-Ram-Ram} (and so on, with or without charm), or honour Vishnu with his thousand names,* or Allah with his ninety-nine; or they may use prayer-mills and rosaries — the main point is that this work keeps them still for a time and makes them a tolerable sight: their type of prayer has been invented for the benefit of the pious who know thoughts and elevations of their own. And even they have their tired hours, when a string of venerable words and sounds and a mechanical piety do them good. But supposing these rare human beings — in every religion the religious person is an exception — can figure out what to do; those who are poor in spirit cannot figure out 12 This is a formula which adepts repeat in certain forms of Buddhist meditation as a help to attaining spiritual enlightenment. The literal meaning seems to be something like: 'You [Buddha] the centre of the lotus-flower'. 3 The god of a monotheistic Hindu cult centred in Benares 14 One of the major gods of the Hindu pantheon 122 Book Three what to do, and to forbid them their prayer-rattling is to deprive them of their religion — as Protestantism increasingly shows us more and more. From such people religion wants only that they keep still] with their eyes, hands, legs, and other organs; thus they are made beautiful for a time and — more like human beings! 129 The conditions for God. — "God himself cannot exist without wise people", said Luther!> and with good reason; but 'God can exist even less without unwise people' — that our good Luther did not say! 130 A dangerous decision. ~- The Christian decision to find the world ugly and bad has made the world ugly and

bad. 131 Christianity and suicide. ~ When Christianity came into existence the inclination to suicide was very strong — Christianity turned it into a lever of its power: it allowed only two kinds of suicide, dressed them up with the highest dignity and the highest hopes and forbade all others in a terrible manner. But martyrdom and the ascetic's slow suicide were permitted. 132 Against Christianity. - What decides against Christianity now is our taste, not our reasons. 133 Principle. - An inescapable hypothesis to which humanity must have recourse again and again is still more powerful in the long run than the 15 This passage in Luther's work has not been located. 123 The Gay Science best believed faith in something untrue (such as the Christian faith). In the long run: that means here a hundred thousand years. 134 Pessimists as victims. - Wherever a deep dissatisfaction with existence comes to prevail, it is the aftereffects of some great dietary mistake made by a people over a long time that are coming to light. Thus the spread of Buddhism (not its origin) depended greatly on the Indians' excessive and almost exclusive diet of rice and the general enervation resulting from it. Perhaps the modern European discontent is due to the fact that our prehistory, the entire middle ages, was given to drinking thanks to the influence of Germanic tastes on Europe: the middle ages means the alcohol poisoning of Europe. — The German dissatisfaction with life is essentially a winter sickness exacerbated by the effects of cellar air and the noxious stove fumes in German living rooms. 135 Origin of sin. — Sin, as it is now experienced wherever Christianity reigns or once reigned: sin is a Jewish feeling and a Jewish invention; and given that this is the background of all Christian morality, Christianity can be said to have aimed at 'Judaizing' the whole world. The extent to which this has succeeded in Europe is best brought out by how alien Greek antiquity — a world without feelings of sin — strikes our sensibility as being, despite all the good will expended by entire generations and many excellent individuals to approach and incorporate this world. 'Only when you repent does God have mercy on you' — to a Greek, that is an object of ridicule and an annoyance; he would say, 'Maybe slaves feel that way.' What is here being presupposed is a being who is powerful, supremely powerful and yet enjoys revenge: his power is so great that no harm whatsoever can be done unto him except in matters of honour. Every sin is an injury of respect, a *crimen laesae majestatis divinae*® — and nothing further! Feeling spiritually crushed, degraded, wallowing in the dust — that is the first and last condition of 16 The Roman legal code contained a provision for punishing a crime called *crimen laesae majestatis* which originally seems to have meant denigrating or insulting the honour and dignity of the Roman people. The phrase Nietzsche uses would mean: 'crime of insulting the dignity of god'. 124 Book Three his grace; in sum, restoration of his divine honour! Whether the sin has done any other harm; whether it has planted some deep, growing calamity that seizes and strangles one

person after another like a disease; this honour-craving Oriental couldn't care less: sin is an assault on him, not on humanity! He gives those to whom he grants his grace also this same nonchalance about the natural consequences of sin. God and humanity are here conceived as so separate and opposite that there can basically be no sin against humanity — every deed is supposed to be considered only with respect to its supernatural consequences, not with respect to its natural consequences; that is what Jewish feeling, to which everything natural is indignity itself, demands. The Greeks, by contrast, were closer to the thought that even sacrilege can have dignity — even theft, as in the case of Prometheus;!” even the slaughter of cattle as the expression of an insane envy, as in the case of Ajax;!® in their need to incorporate into and devise some dignity for sacrilege, they invented tragedy — an art form and a pleasure that has remained utterly and profoundly foreign to the Jew, despite all his poetic talent and inclination towards the sublime. 136 The chosen people. — The Jews, who feel they are the chosen people of all peoples precisely because they are the moral genius of all peoples (owing to their ability more profoundly to despise the human being in themselves than any other people) — the Jews take a pleasure in their divine monarch and the holy which is similar to that which the French nobility took in Louis XIV. This nobility had surrendered all its power and sovereignty and had become contemptible: in order not to feel this, in order to be able to forget this, there was a need for a royal splendour, a royal authority and plenitude of power without equal to which only the nobility had access. In rising to the height of the court by virtue of this privilege and seeing from there everything as beneath oneself, as 17 Demi-god who is said to have stolen fire from the gods and to have given it to humans, thereby initiating the process of civilization. An extant tragedy ascribed to Aeschylus treats the punishment of Prometheus for this crime: he was fettered to a rock in the Caucasus while an eagle fed on his liver. See above, Book 1, footnote 1, p. 2g and also below, § 300, p. 170. 18 Because of a slight to his standing as a warrior, Ajax went mad and killed a large number of cattle, deludedly thinking they were the Greek leaders who had wronged him. Sophocles treats this subject in his tragedy Ajax. 125 The Gay Science contemptible, one got over an irritable conscience. Thus one deliberately built the tower of royal power ever higher into the clouds and staked on it the ultimate building stones of one's own power. 137 Speaking in a parable. - A Jesus Christ was possible only in a Jewish landscape — I mean one over which the gloomy and sublime thunder clouds of the wrathful Jehovah hovered continually. Here alone was the rare and sudden piercing of a single sunbeam through the gruesome general and perpetual day-night experienced as a miracle of 'love', as the ray of the most undeserved 'grace'. Only here could Christ dream of his rainbow and his heavenly ladder on which God descended to man; everywhere else good weather and sunshine were too much of a rule and everyday

occurrence. 138 Christ's error. — The founder of Christianity thought that there was nothing from which men suffered more than their sins. That was his error — the error of one who felt himself free of sin and who lacked experience of it! Thus his soul filled itself with that wonderful fantastic compassion for a torment that was rarely a very great torment even among his people, who invented sin! But the Christians have found a way of retroactively vindicating their master and of sanctifying his error into 'truth'. 139 The colour of the passions. — People like St Paul have an 'evil eye' for the passions: they come to know only what is dirty, disfiguring, and heart-breaking about them; hence their ideal impulse seeks the annihilation of the passions, which they see totally purified in the divine. Quite unlike St Paul and the Jews, the Greeks turned their ideal impulse precisely towards the passions and loved, elevated, gilded and deified them; evidently passion made them feel not only happier but also purer and more divine than usual. And the Christians? Did they want to become Jews in this respect? Did they perhaps succeed? 126 Book Three 140 Too Jewish. — If God wanted to become an object of love, he should first of all have had to give up judging and justice: a judge, even a merciful one, is no object of love. The founder of Christianity lacked delicacy of feeling in this regard, being a Jew. 141 Too oriental. — What? A god who loves men provided that they believe in him and who casts evil gazes and threats at anyone who does not believe in this love? What? A love hemmed in by conditions as the feeling of an almighty god? A love that has not even mastered the feeling of honour and roused vengefulness? How oriental this all is! 'If I love you, what does that concern you???' is surely a sufficient critique of all of Christianity. 142 Incense. — Buddha says: 'Don't flatter your benefactors!' Repeat this saying in a Christian church and it will instantly clear the air of everything Christian. 143 The greatest advantage of polytheism. — For an individual to posit his own ideal and to derive from it his own law, joys and rights — that may well have been considered hitherto to be the most outrageous of human aberrations and idolatry itself; indeed, the few who dared it always felt the need to apologize to themselves, usually as follows: 'Not I! Not I! But a god through me!' The wonderful art and power of creating gods — polytheism — was that through which this drive could discharge itself, purify, perfect and ennoble itself; for originally it was a base and undistinguished drive, related to stubbornness, disobedience, and envy. To be hostile to this drive to have one's own ideal: that was formerly the law of every morality. There was only one norm: 'the human being' — 19 Goethe, *Wilhelm Meister*, Book tv, chapter 9; *Dichtung und Wahrheit*, Book 111, chapter 14 127 The Gay Science and every people believed itself to have this one and ultimate norm. But above and outside oneself, in a distant overworld, one got to see a plurality of norms: one god was not the denial of or anathema to another god! Here for the first time one allowed oneself individuals; here one first honoured the rights of individuals.

The invention of gods, heroes, and overmen (Übermenschen) of all kinds, as well as deviant or inferior forms of humanoid life (Neben- und Untermenschen), dwarfs, fairies, centaurs, satyrs, demons, and devils, was the invaluable preliminary exercise for the justification of the egoism and sovereignty of the individual: the freedom that one conceded to a god in his relation to other gods one finally gave to oneself in relation to laws, customs, and neighbours.

Monotheism, in contrast, this rigid consequence of the teachings of a normal human type — that is, the belief in a normal god next to whom there are only false pseudo-gods — was perhaps the greatest danger to humanity so far: it threatened us with that premature stagnation which, as far as we can tell, most other species have long reached; for all of them believe in one normal type and ideal for their species and have translated the morality of custom (Sittlichkeit der Sitte) definitively into flesh and blood. In polytheism the free-spiritedness and many-spiritedness of humanity received preliminary form — the power to create for ourselves our own new eyes and ever again new eyes that are ever more our own — so that for humans alone among the animals there are no eternal horizons and perspectives. 144 Religious wars. — The greatest progress of the masses up till now has been the religious war, for it proves that the mass has begun to treat concepts with respect. Religious wars start only when the finer quarrels among sects have refined common reason so that even the mob becomes subtle and takes trifles seriously, and actually considers it possible that the ‘eternal salvation of the soul’ might hinge on slight differences between concepts. 145 Danger for vegetarians. ~ A diet consisting primarily of rice leads to the use of opium and narcotics, just as a diet consisting primarily of potatoes 128 Book Three leads to the use of liquor. But its subtler effects also include ways of thinking and feeling that work narcotically. This harmonizes with the fact that the promoters of narcotic ways of thinking and feeling, like those Indian gurus, praise precisely a diet that is purely vegetarian and would like to make that a law of the masses: thus they want to call forth and increase a need that they are able to satisfy. 146 German hopes. ~ Let us not forget that names of peoples are usually terms of abuse. The Tartars, for example, are literally ‘the dogs’; that is what the Chinese called them. The ‘Germans’: this originally meant ‘heathen’; that is what the Goths after their conversion named the great mass of their unbaptized kindred tribes, in accordance with their translation of the Septuagint” in which the heathens were designated with a word that in Greek means ‘the nations’; see Ulfilas.”) It would still be possible for the Germans to turn the term of abuse for them into a name of honour by becoming the first un-Christian nation in Europe: for which Schopenhauer honoured them as having a very strong predisposition. That would be a way of fulfilling the words of Luther, who taught them to be un-Roman and to say: ‘Here I stand! I can do no other!’ 22 147 Question and answer. — What do savage tribes today take over first of all from the Europeans?

Liquor and Christianity, the narcotics of Europe. And from what do they perish most quickly? From European narcotics. 20 Translation of the Old Testament into Greek for the use of Greek-speaking Jews, produced between the third century Bc and the beginning of the Christian era A fourth-century (aD) Gothic bishop who is responsible for the translation of the Bible into Gothic. Nietzsche is claiming that the German word for 'German' (deutsch) is etymologically related to the Gothic word thuida ('people'), and that Ulfilas used this word to render the Greek 'τέθνηκα' in the Septuagint which originally just meant 'nations', but came to be used by Christians to refer specifically to 'heathens'. Nietzsche discusses this paragraph of the text in his letter to Peter Gast of 30 July 1882. Probably apocryphal reply Luther is said to have given at the Diet of Worms (18 April 1521) to the demand that he recant 22 n 129 The Gay Science 148 Where reformations arise. — At the time of the great corruption of the Church, the Church in Germany was the least corrupt; that is why the Reformation occurred here, as a sign that even the beginnings of corruption were felt to be intolerable. For relatively speaking, no people has ever been more Christian than the Germans at the time of Luther; their Christian culture was ready to burst into a hundredfold splendour of blossoms — only one more night was needed, but this brought the storm that put an end to everything. 149 The failure of reformations. — That several attempts to found new Greek religions have failed testifies to the higher culture of the Greeks even in rather early times; it indicates that even early in Greece, there must have been many diverse individuals whose diverse plights could not be disposed of with a single prescription of faith and hope. Pythagoras" and Plato, perhaps Empedocles"* as well, and the Orphic enthusiasts" much earlier yet, were out to found new religions; and the former two had souls and talents which were so much those of founders of religions that one cannot wonder enough at their failure; yet all they managed to found were sects. Every time the reformation of an entire people fails and only sects raise their heads, one may conclude that the people is already very heterogeneous and is starting to break away from crude herd instincts and the morality of custom (Sittlichkeit der Sitte): a notable hovering condition which one usually disparages as decay in morals and corruption, when in fact it announces the maturation of the egg and the impending breaking of the eggshell. That Luther's reformation succeeded in the North is a sign of the fact that the North was backward in comparison to the South and still had rather uniform and monochrome needs; Europe would not have been christianized at all had not the culture of the old world of the South gradually been barbarized through an excessive admixture of Germanic barbarian 23 See above, Book 11, footnote 23, p. 84. 24 See above, Book 11, footnote 25, p. 84. 25 Orphism was an obscure but powerful religious movement that seems to have originated in the sixth century BC. It was often associated with the view that the soul could live on after death.

130 Book Three blood and its cultural superiority lost. The more general and unconditional the influence of an individual or an individual's thought can be, the more homogeneous and the lower must the mass be that is influenced, while counter-movements betray inner counter-needs that also want satisfaction and recognition. Conversely, one may always infer a high level of culture when powerful and domineering natures only manage to have a slight and sectarian influence: this is also true of the individual arts and the areas of knowledge. Where there is ruling, there are masses; where there are masses, there is a need for slavery. Where there is slavery, there are few individuals, and these have herd instincts and conscience against them. 150 Towards a critique of saints. - Must one then, in order to have a virtue, want to have it in its most brutal form — the way the Christian saints wanted and needed it, as those who endured life only with the thought that the mere sight of their virtue would destroy the self-esteem of anyone who viewed it? But a virtue with such an effect I call brutal. 151 On the origin of religion. - The metaphysical need is not the origin of religion, as Schopenhauer"® has it, but only a date offshoot of it. Under the rule of religious ideas, one has got used to the idea of 'another world (behind, below, above)' and feels an unpleasant emptiness and deprivation at the annihilation of religious delusions — and from this feeling grows now 'another world', but this time only a metaphysical and not a religious one. But what led to the belief in 'another world' in primordial times was not a drive or need, but an error in the interpretation of certain natural events, an embarrassing lapse of the intellect. 152 The greatest change. — The lighting and colours of everything have changed! We no longer fully understand how the ancients experienced 26 In his 'Uber Religion' in *Parerga und Paralipomena*, vol. 11, chapter 15 131 The Gay Science what was most familiar and frequent — for example the day and waking. Because the ancients believed in dreams, waking life had a different light. The same goes for the whole of life, illuminated by a light radiated back on it from death and its significance: our 'death' is a completely different death. All experiences shone differently because a god glowed from them; all decisions and prospects concerning the distant future as well, for one had oracles and secret signs and believed in prophecy. 'Truth' was formerly experienced differently because the lunatic could be considered its mouthpiece — which makes us shudder and laugh. Every injustice affected feelings differently, for one feared divine retribution and not just a civil punishment and dishonour. What was joy in an age when one believed in devils and tempters! What was passion when one saw the demons lurking nearby! What was philosophy when doubt was felt as a sin of the most dangerous kind, as a sacrilege against eternal love, as mistrust of everything that is good, lofty, pure, and merciful! We have given things a new colour; we keep on painting them — but what can we nowadays accomplish in comparison to the splendour of colour of that old master! I mean ancient

humanity. 153 *Homo poeta*.” — “I myself, who most single-handedly made this tragedy of tragedies, insofar as it is finished; I, having first tied the knot of morality into existence and drawn it so tight that only a god can loosen it — which is what Horace demands! — I myself have now in the fourth act slain all gods, out of morality! What is now to become of the fifth act? From where shall I take the tragic solution? Should I start considering a comic solution?” 154 Different types of danger in life. ~ You have no idea what you are experiencing; you run through life as if you were drunk and once in a while fall down a staircase. But thanks to your drunkenness, you don’t break your limbs in the process; your muscles are too slack and your 27 ‘The human being as poet’ 28 *Ars poetica*, 18off. 132 Book Three head too dull for you to find the stones of these stairs as hard as the rest of us do! For us, life is a greater danger: we are made of glass — woe unto us if we bump against something! And everything is lost if we fall! 155 What we lack. — We love what is great in nature and have discovered it — because in our heads, great human beings are lacking. It was the other way around for the Greeks; their feeling for nature is different from ours. 156 The most influential. ~ That a human being resists his whole age, stops it at the gate and demands an accounting — that must exercise an influence! Whether he wants to is irrelevant; that he can is what matters. 157 *Mentiri*.?? — Watch out! He’s thinking; in a moment he will have a lie ready. This is a stage of culture at which entire peoples have stood. Just consider what the Romans meant by the word *mentiri*! 158 An uncomfortable trait. — To find all things deep — that is an uncomfortable trait: it makes one constantly strain one’s eyes and in the end always find more than one had wished. 159 Every virtue has its age. ~ Whoever is unyielding these days will often have pangs of conscience because of his candour; for unyieldingness and candour are virtues that belongs to different ages. 29 ‘to lie’ (Latin); etymologically related to *mens* (‘mind’) and *memini* (‘bear in mind’, ‘remember’) 133 *The Gay Science* 160 Dealing with virtues. — To a virtue, too, one can be undignified and fawning. 161 To the lovers of the age. - The ex-priest and the ex-convict constantly make faces: what they want is a face without a past. — But have you ever seen people who know that the future is mirrored in their faces and are so polite to you, you lovers of ‘the age’, that they make a face without a future? 162 Egoism. — Egoism is the perspectival law of feeling according to which what is closest appears large and heavy, while in the distance everything decreases in size and weight. 163 After a great victory. — The best thing about a great victory is that it takes the fear of defeat out of the victor. ‘Why not also be defeated once?’ he says to himself; ‘I’m rich enough for that now.’ 164 The seekers of rest. — I recognize the spirits who seek rest by the many dark objects with which they surround themselves: he who wants to sleep makes his room dark or crawls into a cave. — A hint to those who don’t know, but would like to know, what they actually seek most! 165 On the happiness of

those who renounce something. - He who thoroughly forgoes something for a long time will, upon accidentally re-encountering it, almost think he has discovered it — and what happiness every discoverer has! Let us be wiser than the snakes who lie too long in the same sunlight. 134 Book Three 166 Always in our company. — Everything that is of my kind, in nature and history, speaks to me, praises me, spurs me on, comforts me — everything else I don't hear or forget right away. We are always only in our own company. 167 Misanthropy and love. — One speaks of being sick of people only when one can no longer digest them and yet still has one's stomach full of them. Misanthropy is the result of an all-too-greedy love of man and 'cannibalism' — but who told you to swallow men like oysters, my Prince Hamlet? 168 About a sick man. ~ 'He is doing badly! — 'What's wrong?' — 'He is suffering from the desire to be praised and finds no nourishment for it.' — 'Unbelievable! The whole world is celebrating him, and pampering him; he is on everyone's lips.' — 'Yes, but he has a bad ear for praise. If a friend praises him, it sounds to him as if the friend is praising himself. If an enemy praises him, it sounds to him as if the enemy wants to be praised for that. And when finally he is praised by any of the rest — and they are not many at all; that is how famous he is! — it offends him that they don't want him as a friend or enemy; he likes to say: What do I care about people who are capable of trying to play "the just man" even towards me?' 169 Open enemies. ~ Courage before the enemy is one thing; it does not prevent one from being a coward and indecisive scatterbrain. That is how Napoleon judged 'the most courageous person' he knew: Murat." — Which shows that open enemies are indispensable to some people if they are to rise to their own kind of virtue, manliness, and cheerfulness. 30 French general (1767~1815). Nietzsche takes the anecdote from his usual source about Napoleon, the *Mémoires* of Madame de Rémusat (see above, Book 1, footnote 16, p. 49). 135 The Gay Science 170 With the crowd. — So far he is still running with the crowd and singing its praises, but one day he will become its opponent! For he is following it thinking that this will give his laziness full play, and he has not yet discovered that the crowd is not lazy enough for him! That it always pushes ahead! That it allows no one to stand still! - And he so much likes to stand still! 171 Fame. — When the gratitude of many towards one throws away all shame, fame arises. 172 The spoiler of taste. — A: 'You are a spoiler of taste — that is what everyone says!' B: 'Of course! I spoil for everyone the taste for his own party — and no party forgives that.' 173 Being deep and seeming deep. - Those who know they are deep strive for clarity. Those who would like to seem deep to the crowd strive for obscurity. For the crowd takes everything whose ground it cannot see to be deep: it is so timid and so reluctant to go into the water. 174 Aside. — Parliamentarianism, i.e. the public permission to choose between five basic political opinions, flatters and wins the favour of all those who like to appear independent and individualistic and would

like to fight for their opinions. In the end, however, it is irrelevant whether the herd is commanded to have one opinion or permitted to have five. Whoever deviates from the five public opinions and steps aside will always have the whole herd against him. 136 Book Three 175 On eloquence. — Who has had the most convincing eloquence so far? The drum roll; and as long as kings and commanders have control over that, they will remain the best orators and rabble rousers. 176 Compassion. — Those poor reigning princes! All their rights are now suddenly turning into claims, and all these claims soon begin to sound like presumptions! The moment they merely say ‘We’ or ‘my people’, wicked old Europe starts to smile. Verily, a chief master of ceremonies in the modern world would waste little ceremony on them and might perhaps decree: ‘les souverains rangent aux parvenus.’>! 177 On ‘the educational establishment’. - In Germany, higher men lack one great means of education: the laughter of higher men; for in Germany, these do not laugh. 178 On moral enlightenment. — One must talk the Germans out of their Mephistopheles, and their Faust, too. They are two moral prejudices against the value of knowledge.” 179 Thoughts. — Thoughts are the shadows of our sensations — always darker, emptier, simpler. 31 ‘sovereigns rank with parvenus’ 32 In Goethe’s drama Faust, Mephistopheles is a ‘spirit who always says “no”?’ (Act 1, line 1338); Faust seeks for an experience so satisfying that he will wish time to stand still so that he can hold on to it (Act 1, lines 1675-1706). 137 The Gay Science 180 The good age for free spirits. — Free spirits take liberties even with science ~ and for the time being, one also allows them to — as long as the Church is still standing! To that extent they now have their good age. 181 Following and leading. — A: ‘Of these two, one will always follow and the other will always lead, wherever fate may take them. And yer the former is superior to the other in virtue and spirit!’ B: ‘And yet? And yet? That was said for the others, not for me, not for us! — Fit secundum regulam.’* 182 In solitude. - When one lives alone, one neither speaks too loud nor writes too loud, for one fears the hollow echo — the criticism of the nymph Echo. And all voices sound different in solitude! 183 The music of the best future. — I would consider the foremost musician to be the one who knew only the sadness of the deepest happiness, and no other sadness at all; there has never been such a musician. 184 Justice. ~ Yd rather let myself be robbed than be surrounded by scarecrows — that is my taste. And in any case it is a matter of taste — nothing more! 185 Poor. ~ Today he is poor, not because they have taken everything away from him but because he has thrown everything away. What is that to him? He is used to finding things. It is the poor who misunderstand his voluntary poverty. 33 *This takes place according to the rule.’ 138 Book Three 186 Bad conscience. — Everything he does now is upright and orderly — and still he has a bad conscience. For the extraordinary is his task. 187 What is offensive in the presentation. — This artist offends me in the way he presents his ideas, his very

good ideas: so broad and emphatic, and with such crude artifices of persuasion, as if he were speaking to a mob. Whenever we devote some time to his art, it is soon as if we were 'in bad company'. 188 Work. — How close work and the worker are now even to the most leisurely among us! The royal courtesy of the words 'We are all workers!' would still have been a cynicism and an indecency under the reign of Louis XIV. 189 The thinker. — He is a thinker: that means he knows how to make things simpler than they are. 190 Against those who praise. — A: 'One is praised only by one's peers.' B: "Yes! And whoever praises you tells you: you are my peer!" 191 Against many a defence. - The most perfidious way of damaging a cause is deliberately to defend it with faulty arguments. 192 The good-natured. - What distinguishes those good-natured people whose faces radiate good will from the rest? They feel well in the presence of another person and quickly fall in love with him; consequently they wish him well, and their first judgement is: 'I like him.' In such people there is the following succession: the wish to appropriate (they do not scruple much over the worth of the other person), quick appropriation, delight in possession, and action for the benefit of the person possessed. 193 Kant's joke. - Kant wanted to prove, in a way that would dumbfound the whole world, that the whole world was right: that was the secret joke of this soul. He wrote against the scholars in favour of popular prejudice, but for scholars and not for the people. 194 The 'openhearted' one. - That person probably always acts according to secret reasons, for he always has communicable reasons on his tongue and virtually in his open hand. 195 Laughable. — Look! Look! He is running away from people, but they follow him because he is running ahead of them — that is how much they are a herd! 196 Limits of our sense of hearing. - One hears only those questions to which one is able to find an answer. 197 Better be careful! ~ There is nothing we like so much to impart to others as the seal of secrecy — along with what is under it. 140 Book Three 198 Chagrin of the proud one. — The proud man feels chagrined even by those who bring him forward: he gives the horse of his carriage the evil eye. 199 Generosity. — With the rich, generosity is often just a type of shyness. 200 Laughter. - Laughter means: to gloat, but with a good conscience. 201 Applause. — In applause there is always a kind of noise — even in the applause we give ourselves. 202 A squanderer. — As yet he does not have that poverty of the rich man who has already counted his entire treasure once — he squanders his spirit with the unreason of a squandering nature. 203 Hic niger est.>+ — Usually he has no thought — but on rare occasions bad thoughts come to him. 204 Beggars and courtesy. — 'One isn't being impolite if one uses a stone to knock on a door which lacks a doorbell': that is how beggars think, and everyone who is suffering some kind of distress, but no one thinks they are right. 34 'A dangerous man, this one' (literally "This one is black"); Horace, Satires 4,85 141 The Gay Science 205 Need. — Need is taken to be the

cause why something came to be; in reality, it is often merely an effect of what has come to be. 206 When it rains. — It is raining, and I think of the poor who now huddle together with their many troubles and without any practice at concealing them: each is ready to hurt the other and to make for himself a pitiful kind of pleasure even when the weather is bad. That and that alone is the poverty of the poor! 207 The envious one. — He is envious — let's hope he won't have any children; he would envy them because he can no longer be a child. 208 Great man! — From the fact that someone is a 'great man' one cannot infer that he is a man; he may be just a boy, or a chameleon of all stages of life, or a bewitched little woman. 209 A way of asking for reasons. — There is a way of asking us for our reasons that not only makes us forget our best reasons but also awakens in us a defiance and resistance towards reasons in general — a very stultifying mode of asking and a trick used by tyrannical people! 210 Moderation in diligence. - One should not try to surpass one's father in diligence; that makes one sick. 211 Secret enemies. — To be able to afford a secret enemy — that is a luxury for which the morality even of elevated spirits is usually not rich enough. 142 Book Three 212 Not to let oneself be deceived. — His spirit has bad manners, is hasty and always stutters out of impatience; hence one hardly recognizes how much stamina and robustness the soul possesses in which this spirit dwells. 213 The road to happiness. — A wise man asked a fool what the road to happiness is. The latter replied without delay, like someone being asked the way to the nearest town: 'Admire yourself and live on the street!' 'Stop,' replied the sage, 'you are asking too much; it is quite enough to admire oneself!' The fool countered: 'But how can one constantly admire without constantly feeling contempt?' 214 Faith makes blessed. — Virtue gives happiness and a type of blessedness only to those who have not lost faith in their virtue — not to those subtler souls whose virtue consists of a deep mistrust of themselves and of all virtue. So in the end, here, too, 'faith makes blessed'*> — and, mind you, not virtue! 215 Ideal and material. — You envisage a noble ideal, but are you such a noble stone that such a divine image could be fashioned out of you? And anyway — isn't all your work a barbarous sculpting? A blasphemy against your ideal? 216 Danger in the voice. - With a very loud voice in one's throat one is almost incapable of thinking subtle things. 35 Gospel according to Mark 16.16 143 The Gay Science 217 Cause and effect. — Before the effect one believes in causes different from those one believes in after the effect. 218 My antipathy. — I do not love people who have to explode like bombs in order to have any effect whatsoever and in whose presence one is always in danger of suddenly losing one's hearing — or more. 219 The purpose of punishment. - The purpose of punishment is to improve the one who punishes; that is the last resort of the apologists for punishment. 220 Sacrifice. — The sacrificial animal thinks differently about sacrifice than the spectator, but one has never let it have its say. 221 Forbearance. — Fathers and

sons have much more forbearance for each other than mothers and daughters. 222 Poet and har. — The poet sees in the liar a foster brother (Milchbruder) whose milk he has drunk up; that is why the latter has remained stunted and miserable and has not even got as far as having a good conscience. 223 Vicariousness of the senses. — ‘Our eyes are also intended for hearing’, said the old father confessor who had gone deaf, ‘and among the blind he is king who has the longest ears.’ 144 Book Three 224 Animals’ criticism. — | fear that the animals see man as a being like them who in a most dangerous manner has lost his animal common sense — as the insane animal, the laughing animal, the weeping animal, the miserable animal. 225 The natural. — ‘Evil has always had great effects in its favour! And nature is evil! Let us therefore be natural!’ That is the secret reasoning of the great effect-artists of humanity, who have all too often been considered great human beings. 226 The distrustful and style. — We say the strongest things simply, provided that we are among people who believe in our strength — such an environment breeds ‘simplicity of style’. The distrustful speak emphatically; the distrustful make emphatic. 227 Bad inference; bad shot. — He cannot control himself; from that, a woman infers that it would be easy to control him and casts her net for him — the poor woman who will shortly be his slave. 228 Against mediators. - He who wants to mediate between two resolute thinkers shows that he is mediocre: he has no eye for what is unique; seeing things as similar and making things the same is the sign of weak eyes. 229 Obstinacy and faithfulness. - From defiance he clings to something he has come to see through, but he calls it ‘faithfulness’. 145 The Gay Science 230 Lack of silence. — His whole being fails to persuade — that is because he has never remained silent about any of his good deeds. 231 The ‘thorough’. — Those who are slow to know think that slowness is an aspect of knowledge. 232 Dreaming. — Either one does not dream, or does so interestingly. One should learn to spend one’s waking life in the same way: not at all, or interestingly. 233 The most dangerous point of view. — What I now do or omit is as important for everything that is to come as the greatest event of the past: seen from this tremendous perspective, from that of their effects, all actions appear equally great and small. 234 Words of comfort for a musician. — ‘Your life does not reach men’s ears; to them you live a mute life, and all the subtlety of melody, all tender resolution about following or leading, remain hidden from them. It is true: you are not coming down a main street with regimental music, but that does not give these good people the right to say your way of life lacks music. He who has ears to hear, let him hear!’ 235 Spirit and character. - Some reach their peak as characters, but their Spirit is not adequate for this height, while with others it is the other way around, Book Three 236 In order to move the crowd. — Must not he who wants to move the crowd be an actor playing the role of himself? Must he not first translate himself into the grotesquely obvious and present his entire

person and cause in this coarsened and simplified version? 237 The polite one. - 'He is so polite!' — Yes, he always carries a cake for Cerberus" and is so timid that he takes everyone for Cerberus, even you and me; that is his 'politeness'. 238 Without envy. — He is quite without envy, but that has no merit because he wants to conquer a country that no one has yet possessed and hardly anyone has ever seen. 239 The joyless one. — One single joyless person is enough to create constant sullenness and dark skies for a an entire household, and only a miracle can cause that one person to be lacking! Happiness is not nearly as contagious a disease — why is that? 240 At the sea. — I wouldn't build a house for myself (and it is part of my good fortune not to be a home-owner!). But if I had to, I would, like some Romans, build it right into the sea —I certainly would like to share a few secrets with this beautiful monster. 241 Work and artist. — This artist is ambitious, nothing more: ultimately his work is just a magnifying glass that he offers everyone who looks his way. 36 Three-headed dog who guarded the gates to hell. It was thought that he could sometimes be mollified by being given a honey~cake. 147 The Gay Science 242 *Suum cuique.**' — However great my greed for knowledge may be, I cannot take anything else out of things than what already belongs to me — what belongs to others remains behind. How is it possible for a human being to be a thief or a robber! 243 Origin of 'good' and 'bad'. — An improvement is invented only by someone who is able to feel 'this is not good'. 244 Thoughts and words. — Even one's thoughts one cannot entirely repro- duce in words. 245 Praise by choice. — The artist chooses his subjects; that is his way of praising. 246 Mathematics. — Let us introduce the subtlety and rigour of mathematics into all sciences to the extent to which that is at all possible; not in the belief that we will come to know things this way, but in order to ascertain our human relation to things. Mathematics is only the means to general and final knowledge of humanity. 247 Habit. — Every habit makes our hand more witty and our wit less handy. 248 Books. — What good is a book that does not even carry us beyond all books? 37 *To each his own'. Definition of justice found, for instance, in Cicero, *De officiis* 1.15 148 Book Three 249 The sigh of the one who comes to know. — 'Oh, my greed! In this soul there dwells no selflessness but rather an all-desiring self that would like, as it were, to see with the eyes and seize with the hands of many individuals ~a self that would like to bring back the entire past, that wants to lose nothing it could possibly possess! Oh, this flame of my greed! Oh, that I might be reborn into a hundred beings!' — Whoever does not know this sigh from experience does not know the passion of coming to know. 250 Guilt. — Although the shrewdest judges of the witches and even the witches themselves were convinced of the guilt of witchcraft, this guilt still did not exist. This is true of all guilt. 251 Misunderstood sufferers. — Great natures suffer differently from what their admirers imagine: they suffer most severely from the ignoble, petty agitations of

some evil moments — in short, from their doubts about their own greatness — and not from the sacrifices and martyrdoms that their task demands from them. As long as Prometheus has pity for men and sacrifices himself for them, he is happy and great; but when he is envious of Zeus and the homage paid to him by mortals, then he suffers! 252 Better in debt. ~ ‘Better to remain in debt than to pay with a coin that does not bear our image!’ says our sovereignty. 253 Always at home. — One day we reach our goal — and now we point with pride to the long journeys we took to reach it. In truth we did not notice we were travelling. But we got so far because at each point we believed we were at home. 149 The Gay Science 254 Against embarrassment. — Whoever is always deeply occupied is beyond all embarrassment. 255 Imitators. — A: ‘What? You want no imitators?’ B: ‘I don’t want people to imitate me; I want everyone to set his own example, which is what [do.’ A: ‘So —?? 256 Skinnedness. — All people of depth find happiness in being for once like flying fish, playing on the outermost crests of waves; what they consider best in things is that they have a surface: their skinnedness — sé vensa verbo.® 257 From experience. — Some do not know how rich they are until they experience what kinds of rich people will steal from them. 258 Those who deny chance. — No victor believes in chance. 259 From paradise. — ‘Good and evil are the prejudices of God’ — said the snake. 260 One times one. — One is always wrong; but with two, truth begins. — One cannot prove his case, but two are already irrefutable. 38 4f you allow me to use this word’ 150 Book Three 261 Originality. — What is originality? To see something that still has no name; that still cannot be named even though it is lying right before everyone’s eyes. The way people usually are, it takes a name to make something visible at all. - Those with originality have usually been the name-givers. 262 Sub specie aeterni.*? — A: ‘You are moving ever faster from the living; soon they will strike you out of their lists!’ — B: “That is the only way to participate in the privilege of the dead.’ — A: ‘What privilege?’ — B: ‘No longer to die.’ 263 Without vanity. - When we are in love we want our defects to remain hidden — not from vanity but so the loved one won’t suffer. Yes, the lover would like to be godlike — also not from vanity. 264 What we do. — What we do is never understood but always merely praised and reproached. 265 Ultimate doubt. - What, then, are man’s truths ultimately? — They are the irrefutable errors of man. 266 Where cruelty is needed. - He who has greatness is cruel to his virtues and secondary considerations. 39 ‘from the point of view of eternity’ 151 The Gay Science 267 With a great goal. — With a great goal one is superior even to justice, not only to one’s deeds and judges. 268 What makes one heroic? — To approach at the same time one’s highest suffering and one’s highest hope. 269 What do you believe in? — In this: that the weight of all things must be determined anew. 270 What does your conscience say? ~ ‘You should become who you are.” 271 Where lie your greatest dangers? — In compassion.

272 What do you love in others? — My hopes. 273 Whom do you call bad?— He who always wants to put people to shame. 49 This is a slightly truncated version of a famous passage from a victory-ode by the early fifth- century (BC) poet Pindar, his Second Pythian Victory-Ode (line 73). The original Pindar passage reads: ‘Become who you are through knowing’. The implication is that the ode should inform the victorious young aristocrat of the great deeds of his ancestors and thereby inspire him to live up to them. For Nietzsche the saying had deeper implications of self-discovery and self-realization: ‘How one becomes what one is’ is the sub-title of *Ecce Homo*, his reflection on his own work, which was written in 1888. 152 Book Three 274 What is most human to you? — ‘To spare someone shame. 275 What is the seal of having become free? — No longer to be ashamed before oneself. 153 Book Four St Januarius You who with your lances burning Melt the ice sheets of my soul, Speed it toward the ocean yearning For its highest hope and goal: Ever healthier it rises, Free in fate most amorous: — Thus your miracle it prizes Fairest Januarius! Genoa in January 1882 Januarius is the first month of the Roman civil calendar. The name might (or might not) be connected with that of the deity Janus, the god of doors and entrances. St Januarius (in Italian San Gennaro) was an early Christian martyr, a vial of whose dried blood is kept in a church in Naples. On certain feast days the blood is said miraculously to become fluid again. Book Four: St Januarius 276 For the new year. — Ym still alive; I still think: I must still be alive because I still have to think. Sum, ergo cogito: cogito, ergo sum.! Today everyone allows himself to express his dearest wish and thoughts: so I, too, want to say what I wish from myself today and what thought first crossed my heart — what thought shall be the reason, warrant, and sweetness of the rest of my life! I want to learn more and more how to see what is necessary in things as what is beautiful in them — thus I will be one of those who make things beautiful. *Amor fati*:? let that be my love from now on! I do not want to wage war against ugliness. I do not want to accuse; I do not even want to accuse the accusers. Let looking away be my only negation! And, all in all and on the whole: some day I - want only to be a Yes-sayer! 277 Personal providence. ~ There is a certain high point in life; once we have reached it we are, for all our freedom, once more in the greatest danger of spiritual unfreedom; and no matter how much we have confronted the beautiful chaos of existence and denied it all providential reason and goodness, we still have to pass our hardest test. For it is only now that the thought of a personal providence confronts us with the most penetrating force and the best advocate, appearance, speaks for it — now that we so palpably see how everything that befalls us continually turns out for the best. Every day and every hour life seems to want nothing else than to prove this proposition again and again; be it what it may — bad or good weather, the loss of a friend, a sickness, slander, the absence of a letter, the spraining of an ankle, a glance into a

shop, a counter-~ argument, the opening of a book, a dream, fraud — it shows itself immediately or very soon to be something that ‘was not allowed to be lacking’ — it is full of deep meaning and use precisely for us! Is there any more dangerous seduction than to renounce one’s faith in the gods of Epicurus,^o those carefree and unknown ones, and to believe instead in 1 J am, therefore I think: I think, therefore I am.’ In the second of his *Meditations*, Descartes argued that as long as he thought he could be sure he existed. 2 dove of (one’s) fate’ 3 Epicurus thought common views about the gods were completely erroneous; they in fact lived a 157 The Gay Science some petty deity who is full of worries and personally knows every little hair on our heads and finds nothing nauseating in the most miserable small service? Well — I mean in spite of it all! — we should leave the gods alone as well as the genies at our service and be content with the assumption that our own practical and theoretical skill in interpreting and arranging events has now reached its apex. Nor should we think too highly of this dexterity of our wisdom when at times the wonderful harmony created by the playing of our instrument surprises us all too much — a harmony that sounds too good for us to dare to give credit to ourselves. Indeed, now and then someone plays mirth with us — good old chance; occasionally chance guides our hand, and the wisest providence could not invent music more beautiful than what our foolish hand then produces. 278 The thought of death. — It gives me a melancholy happiness to live in the midst of this jumble of lanes, needs, and voices: how much enjoyment, impatience, desire; how much thirsty life and drunkenness of life comes to light every moment of the day! And yet things will soon be so silent for all these noisy, living, life-thirsty ones! How even now everyone’s shadow stands behind him, as his dark fellow traveller! It’s always like the last moment before the departure of an emigrant ship: people have more to say to each other than ever; the hour is late; the ocean and its desolate silence await impatiently behind all the noise — so covetous, so certain of its prey. And everyone, everyone takes the past to be little or nothing while the near future is everything; hence this haste, this clamour, this outshouting and out-hustling one another. Everyone wants to be the first in this future — and yet death and deathly silence are the only things certain and common to all in this future! How strange that this sole certainty and commonality barely makes an impression on people and that they are farthest removed from feeling like a brotherhood of death! It makes me happy to see that people do not at all want to think the thought of death! I would very much like to do something that would make the thought of life even a hundred times more worth being thought to them. perfectly happy and contented life, and this meant that they had no interest in or involvement with the human world at all. 158 Book Four: St Januarius 279 Star friendship. — We were friends and have become estranged. But that was right, and we do not want to hide and obscure it from ourselves as if we had to be ashamed of it. We are two

ships, each of which has its own goal and course; we may cross and have a feast together, as we did — and then the good ships lay so quietly in one harbour and in one sun that it may have seemed as if they had already completed their course and had the same goal. But then the almighty force of our projects drove us apart once again, into different seas and sunny zones, and maybe we will never meet again — or maybe we will, but will not recognize each other: the different seas and suns have changed us! That we had to become estranged is the law above us; through it we should come to have more respect for each other — and the thought of our former friendship should become more sacred! There is probably a tremendous invisible curve and stellar orbit in which our different ways and goals may be included as small stretches — let us rise to this thought! But our life is too short and our vision too meagre for us to be more than friends in the sense of that sublime possibility. — Let us then be/eve in our star friendship even if we must be earth enemies. 280 Architecture for those who wish to pursue knowledge. ~ One day, and probably soon, we will need some recognition of what is missing primarily in our big cities: quiet and wide, expansive places for reflection — places with long, high-ceilinged arcades for bad or all-too-sunny weather, where no shouts or noise from carriages can penetrate and where refined manners would prohibit even priests from praying aloud: a whole complex of buildings and sites that would give expression to the sublimity of contemplation and of stepping aside. The time is past when the Church had a monopoly on contemplation, when the *vita contemplativa**t always had to be first and foremost a *vita religiosa*:> and everything built by the Church gives expression to that idea. I do not see how we could make do with those buildings, even if they were stripped of their churchly purposes; as houses of God and spaces for ostentatiously + ‘contemplative life’ 5 ‘religious life’ 159 The Gay Science displaying our intercourse with the World-Beyond, these buildings speak much that is too emotional and too partisan for us godless ones to be able to think our thoughts here. We want to have us translated into stone and plants; we want to take walks in us when we stroll through these hallways and gardens. 281 Knowing how to end. — Masters of the first rank are recognized by the fact that in matters great and small they know how to find an end perfectly, be it the end of a melody or a thought; of a tragedy’s fifth act or an act of state. The best of the second rank always get restless toward the end, and do not fall into the sea with such proud and calm balance as do, for example, the mountains at Portofino — where the bay of Genoa finishes its melody. 282 Gait. — There are certain tricks of the spirit by which even great minds betray that they come from the mob or half-mob; the gait and stride of their thoughts especially plays the traitor: they cannot walk. Thus Napoleon too, was unable, to his great vexation, to walk in a princely and ‘legitimate’ fashion on occasions that really demanded it, such as great coronation processions; even there, he was always just the leader of a

column ~ proud and hasty at the same time, and very conscious of it. It is laughable to behold those authors who make the ruffled robes of long sentences rustle about themselves: they are trying to hide their feet. 283 Preparatory human beings. — 1 welcome all the signs of a more virile, warlike age approaching that will above all restore honour to bravery! For it shall pave the way for a still higher age and gather the strength that the latter will need one day — the age that will carry heroism into the search for knowledge and wage wars for the sake of thoughts and their consequences. To this end we now need many preparatory brave human beings who surely cannot spring from nothingness any more than from the sand and slime of present-day civilization and urbaniza- 160 Book Four: St Januarius tion: human beings who know how to be silent, lonely, determined, and satisfied and steadfast in invisible activities; human beings profoundly predisposed to look, in all things, for what must be overcome; human beings whose cheerfulness, patience, modesty, and contempt for great vanities is just as distinctive as their magnanimity in victory and patience with the small vanities of the defeated; human beings with a sharp and free judgement concerning all victors and the share of chance in every victory and glory; human beings with their own festivals, their own working days, their own periods of mourning, accustomed to command with assurance and equally prepared, when called for, to obey ~— in each case, equally proud, equally serving their own cause; more endangered, more fruitful, happier human beings! For — believe me — the secret for harvesting from existence the greatest fruitfulness and the greatest enjoyment is — to live dangerously! Build your cities on the slopes of Vesuvius! Send your ships into uncharted seas! Live at war with your peers and yourselves! Be robbers and conquerors as long as you cannot be rulers and possessors, you seekers of knowledge! Soon the time will be past in which you had to be content living hidden in forests like shy deer! Finally the search for knowledge will reach for its due; it will want to rule and possess, and you with it! 284 Faith in oneself. — Few people have faith in themselves — and of these few, some possess it as a useful blindness or partial eclipse of the mind (what would they behold if they could see the bottom of themselves!), while the rest have to acquire it. Everything good, fine, or great they do is first of all an argument against the sceptic inside them. They have to convince or persuade him, and that almost requires genius. These are the great self-dissatisfied people. 285 Excelsior.© — ‘You will never pray again, never adore again, never again rest in endless trust; you refuse to let yourself stop to unharness your thoughts before any ultimate wisdom, goodness, or power; you have no perpetual guard and friend for your seven solitudes; you live without ® ‘higher’ 161 The Gay Science the view of a mountain-range with snow-capped peaks and fire in its heart; there is no avenger for you anymore, no final corrector of the text of your life; there is no more reason in what happens, no love in what will happen to you; no more

resting place stands open for your heart in which to find and no longer seek; you arm yourself against any ultimate peace; you will the eternal recurrence of war and peace; — Man of renunciation, all of this you wish to renounce? Who will give you the strength to do so? No one yet has had the strength!’ There is a lake that one day refused to let itself flow off and formed a dam where it used to flow off: ever since, this lake rises higher and higher. Perhaps this very renunciation will lend us the strength to bear renunciation; perhaps man will rise ever higher when he no longer flows off into a god. 286 Interruption, — These are hopes; but what will you see and hear of them when you have not experienced splendour, ardour, and rosy dawn in your own souls? I can only remind — more I cannot do! To move stones, to turn animals into humans — is that what you want from me? Oh, if you are still stones and animals, you had better look for your Orpheus’ first! 287 Delight in blindness. ~ ‘My thoughts’, said the wanderer to his shadow, ‘should show me where I stand, but they should not betray to me where I am going. I love ignorance of the future and do not want to perish of impatience and premature tasting of things promised.’ 288 High spirits. — It seems to me that most people simply do not believe in elevated moods, unless it be for moments or fifteen-minute intervals at most — except for those few who experience an elevated feeling over a longer period. But to be the human being of one elevated feeling, the embodiment of a single great mood, has hitherto been a mere dream and 7 See above, Book 11, footnote 31, p. 88. 162 Book Four: St FJanuarius enchanting possibility; as yet, history does not offer us any certain examples of it. Nevertheless history might one day beget such people, too, given the creation and determination of a great many preconditions that even the dice rolls of the luckiest chance could not put together today. Perhaps the usual state for these souls would be what has so far entered our souls only as an occasional exception that made us shudder: a perpetual movement between high and low and the feeling of high and low; a continual sense of ascending stairs and at the same time of resting on clouds. 289 Get on the ships! — If one considers how an overall philosophical justification of one’s way of living and thinking affects each individual — namely, like a sun, warming, blessing, impregnating, shining especially for him; how it makes him independent of praise and blame, self-sufficient, rich, generous with happiness and good will; how it incessantly turns evil into good, brings all forces to bloom and ripen and keeps the petty, great weed of melancholy and moroseness from coming up at all — one exclaims longingly, in the end: Oh, how I wish that many such new suns would yet be created! Even the evil man, the unhappy man, and the exceptional man should have their philosophy, their good right, their sunshine! Pity for them is not what is needed! We have to unlearn this arrogant notion, however long humanity has spent learning and practising it — we do not need to present them with confessors, conjurers of souls, and forgivers of sins; rather, a new justice is

needed! And a new motto! And new philosophers! The moral earth, too, is round! The moral earth, too, has its antipodes! The antipodes, too, have their right to exist! There is another world to discover — and more than one! On to the ships, you philosophers! 290 One thing is needful. ~ To ‘give style’ to one’s character — a great and rare art! It is practised by those who survey all the strengths and weaknesses that their nature has to offer and then fit them into an artistic plan until each appears as art and reason and even weaknesses delight the eye. Here a great mass of second nature has been added; there a piece of first 163 The Gay Science nature removed — both times through long practice and daily work at it. Here the ugly that could not be removed is concealed; there it is reinterpreted into sublimity. Much that is vague and resisted shaping has been saved and employed for distant views — it is supposed to beckon towards the remote and immense. In the end, when the work is complete, it becomes clear how it was the force of a single taste that ruled and shaped everything great and small — whether the taste was good or bad means less than one may think; it’s enough that it was one taste! It will be the strong and domineering natures who experience their most exquisite pleasure under such coercion, in being bound by but also perfected under their own law; the passion of their tremendous will becomes less intense in the face of all stylized nature, all conquered and serving nature; even when they have palaces to build and gardens to design, they resist giving nature free rein. Conversely, it is the weak characters with no power over themselves who fate the constraint of style: they feel that if this bitterly evil compulsion were to be imposed on them, they would have to become commonplace under it — they become slaves as soon as they serve; they hate to serve. Such minds — and they may be of the first rank — are always out to shape or interpret their environment as free nature — wild, arbitrary, fantastic, disorderly, and surprising — and they are well advised to do so, because only thus do they please themselves! For one thing is needful: that a human being should attain satisfaction with himself — be it through this or that poetry or art; only then is a human being at all tolerable to behold! Whoever is dissatisfied with himself is continually prepared to avenge himself for this, and we others will be his victims if only by having to endure his sight. For the sight of something ugly makes one bad and gloomy. 291 Genoa. — I have been looking at this city for a long time, at its villas and pleasure-gardens and the wide circumference of its inhabited heights and slopes, and in the end I must say: I see faces that belong to past generations; this region is dotted with images of bold and autocratic human beings. They have veiled and wish to live on — that is what they are telling me with their houses, built and adorned to last for centuries and not for the fleeting hour: they were well disposed towards life, however badly disposed they often may have been towards themselves, I 164 Book Four: St Januarius keep seeing the builder, how he rests his gaze on everything built near

and afar as well as on city, sea, and mountain contours, and how with his gaze he is perpetrating acts of violence and conquest: he wants to fit all this into /zs plan and finally make it his possession by incorporating it into his plan. The whole region is overgrown with this magnificent, insatiable lust for possessions and spoils; and even as these people heeded no boundaries in distant lands and, in their thirst for what was new, placed a new world beside the old one, so, too, at home each flared up against the other and found a way to express his superiority and place his personal infinity between himself and his neighbour. Each conquered his homeland again for himself by overwhelming it with his architectural ideas and refashioning it, so to speak, into a house that was a feast for his eyes. In the North one is impressed by the law and by the general delight in lawfulness and obedience as one considers the way cities are built: this allows one to recognize the inner propensity to uniformity and conformism which must have dominated the souls of all the builders. But here you find, upon turning every corner, a separate human being who knows the sea, adventure, and the Orient; a human being averse to the law and to the neighbour as to a kind of boredom, who measures everything old and established with envious eyes: he would, with a marvellous cunning of imagination, like to establish all this anew at least in thought; to put his hand to it, his meaning into it — if only for the moment of a sunny afternoon when his insatiable and melancholy soul feels sated for once, and only what is his own and nothing alien may appear to his eye.

292 To the preachers of morals. ~ 1 do not want to moralize, but to those who do, I give this advice: if you want eventually to deprive the best things and situations of all their worth, then keep talking about them the way you have been! Place them at the top of your morality and talk from morning till night about the bliss of happiness, the tranquillity of the soul, about justice and immanent retribution — the way you carry on, all these good things will finally attain a popularity and street-clamour of their own, but at the same time all the gold that was on them will have worn off through handling, and all the gold inside will have turned to lead. Verily, you know the art of alchemy in reverse, the devaluation of 165 The Gay Science what is most valuable! Sometime you should try a different prescription to avoid reaching the opposite of what you seek, as you have so far: deny these good things; withdraw from them the mob's acclaim and their easy currency; make them once again the hidden modesty of solitary souls; say that morality is something forbidden! That way you might win over for these things the kind of people who alone matter; I mean the heroic. But then there must be something in them that provokes fear and not, as hitherto, disgust! Isn't it time to say of morality what Master Eckhart said: 'I ask God to rid me of God!'

293 Our air. — We know it very well: to those who glance at science as if passing it on a walk, in the manner of women and unfortunately also many artists, the severity of its service — this inexorability in matters great and small, this swiftness in

weighing, judging, and passing judgement — has something dizzying and fear-inspiring. What frightens them especially is how the hardest is demanded and the best done despite the absence of praise and awards; rather, as among soldiers, what one mostly hears is almost exclusively reproaches and sharp reprimands — for doing things well is considered the rule, and failure the exception; yet here as everywhere else, the rule has a reticent mouth. Now this ‘severity of science’ has something in common with the form and decorum of the very best society: it frightens the uninitiated. But someone accustomed to it wants to live nowhere else than in this bright, transparent, strongly electric air — in this masculine air. Anywhere else is not clean and airy enough for him: he suspects that there, his best art would be of no real use to anyone and of no delight to himself; that among misunderstandings half his life would slip through his fingers; that much caution, much concealment and restraint would constantly be called for — ways of having large amounts of one’s strength sapped uselessly! But in this severe and clear element he has his full strength: here he can fly! Why descend into those murky waters where one has to swim and wade and sully one’s wings? No, it’s too hard for us to live there; it’s not our fault that we were born for the air, for clean air, we rivals of the light beam, and that we would prefer to ride on specks of 8 German mystic (1260~1327). This dictum is to be found in his *Predigten und Schriften* (Frankfurt and Hamburg, 1956) p. 195. 166 Book Four: St Januarius ether, like it — not away from the sun but towards the sun! That, however, we cannot do. So let us do all we can do: bring light to the earth; be ‘the light of the earth’! And for that, we have our wings and our speed and our severity; for that, we are masculine and even terrifying, like fire. May those be terrified of us who do not know how to gain warmth and light from us! 294 Against the slanderers of nature. ~ I find those people unpleasant in whom every natural inclination immediately becomes a sickness, something disfiguring or even contemptible — they have seduced us into the belief that man’s natural inclinations are evil; they are the cause of our great injustice towards our nature, towards a// nature! There are enough people who could well entrust themselves to their inclinations with grace and without care, but who do not for fear of the imagined ‘evil essence’ of nature! That is why there is so little nobility among human beings; its distinguishing feature has always been to have no fear of oneself, to expect nothing contemptible from oneself, to fly without misgivings wherever we’re inclined — we free-born birds! And wherever we arrive, there will always be freedom and sunlight around us. 295 Brief habits. — V love brief habits and consider them invaluable means for getting to know many things and states down to the bottom of their sweetnesss and bitternesses; my nature is designed entirely for brief habits, even in the needs of its physical health and generally as far as I can see at all, from the lowest to the highest. I always believe this will give me lasting satisfaction — even brief habits have this faith of

passion, this faith in eternity — and that I am to be envied for having found and recognized it, and now it nourishes me at noon and in the evening and spreads a deep contentment around itself and into me, so that I desire nothing else, without having to compare, despise, or hate. And one day its time is up; the good thing parts from me, not as something that now disgusts me but peacefully and sated with me, as I with it, and as if we ought to be grateful to each other and so shake hands to say farewell. And already the new waits at the door along with my faith — the 167 The Gay Science indestructible fool and sage! — that this new thing will be the right thing, the last right thing. This happens to me with dishes, thoughts, people, cities, poems, music, doctrines, daily schedules, and ways of living. Enduring habits, however, I hate, and feel as if a tyrant has come near me and the air around me is thickening when events take a shape that seems inevitably to produce enduring habits — for instance, owing to an official position, constant relations with the same people, a permanent residence, or uniquely good health. Yes, at the very bottom of my soul I am grateful to all my misery and illnesses and whatever is imperfect in me because they provide a hundred back doors through which I can escape enduring habits. To me the most intolerable, the truly terrible, would of course be a life entirely without habits, a life that continually demanded improvisation — that would be my exile and my Siberia. 296 A firm reputation. — A firm reputation used to be a thing of utmost utility; and wherever society is still ruled by herd mentality it is still today most expedient for everyone to act as if his character and occupation are unchangeable, even if basically they are not. ‘One can depend on him; he stays the same’: wherever society is threatened this is the type of praise that means the most. Society sees in this person’s virtue, in that person’s ambition, in the thoughtfulness and passion of a third dependable ever-handly instruments. This is a source of great gratification to society, and it bestows on this instrument-nature, this staying-true-to-oneself, this immutability in views, aspirations, and even vices its highest honours. Such esteem, which blooms and has bloomed everywhere alongside the morality of custom (*Sittlichkeit der Sitte*), fosters ‘character’ and brings all change, re-learning, and self-transformation into ill repute. However great the advantages of this mentality may be elsewhere, to the search for knowledge it is the most harmful kind of general judgement, for it condemns and discredits the willingness which a seeker after knowledge must have to declare himself against his previous opinion and to mistrust anything that wishes to become firm in us. The attitude of the seeker after knowledge, which is incompatible with a ‘firm reputation’, is considered dishonourable while the petrification of opinions has all the honour to itself — still today we must live under the spell of such standards! How hard living is when 168 Book Four: St Januarius one feels the judgement of many millennia against and around oneself! It is probable that the search for knowledge was afflicted for many millennia

with a bad conscience and that there must have been much self-contempt and secret misery in the history of the greatest spirits. 297 Being able to contradict. — Everybody knows now that being able to stand contradiction is a high sign of culture. Some even know that the higher human being desires and invites contradiction in order to receive a hint about his own injustice of which he is as yet unaware. But the ability to contradict, the acquired good conscience accompanying hostility towards what is familiar, traditional, hallowed — that is better yet than both those abilities, and constitutes what is really great, new, and amazing in our culture; it is the step of all steps of the liberated spirit: who knows that? 298 Sigh. — 1 caught this insight on the wing and quickly took the nearest shoddy words to fasten it lest it fly away from me. And now it has died of these barren words and hangs and flaps in them — and I hardly know any more, when I look at it, how I could have felt so happy when I caught this bird. 299 What one should learn from artists. - What means do we have for making things beautiful, attractive, and desirable when they are not? And in themselves I think they never are! Here we have something to learn from physicians, when for example they dilute something bitter or add wine and sugar to the mixing bowl; but even more from artists, who are really constantly out to invent new artistic tours de force of this kind. To distance oneself from things until there is much in them that one no longer sees and much that the eye must add in order to see them at all, or to see things around a corner and as if they were cut out and extracted from their context, or to place them so that each partially distorts the view one has of the others and allows only perspectival glimpses, or to 169 The Gay Science look at them through coloured glass or in the light of the sunset, or to give them a surface and skin that is not fully transparent: all this we should learn from artists while otherwise being wiser than they. For usually in their case this delicate power stops where art ends and life begins; me, however, want to be poets of our lives, starting with the smallest and most commonplace details. 300 Preludes to science ~ So you believe the sciences would have emerged and matured, if they had not been preceded by magicians, alchemists, astrologers, and witches who with their promises and false claims created a thirst, hunger, and taste for hidden and forbidden powers? Indeed, infinitely more has had to be promised than can ever be fulfilled in order that anything at all be fulfilled in the realm of knowledge. Those things which now appear to us to be preludes and exercises preparatory to science were in the past certainly not practised and felt to be any such thing. Similarly perhaps to a distant age the whole of religion will appear as an exercise and prelude. Perhaps religion could have been the strange means of making it possible one day for a few individuals to enjoy the whole self-sufficiency of a god and all his power of self-redemption. Indeed — one may ask — would man ever have learned to feel hunger for himself and to find satisfaction and fullness in himself without this religious training and prehistory?

Did Prometheus? first have to imagine having stolen light and pay for it before he could finally discover that he had created light by desiring light, and that not only man but also god was the work of his own hands and clay in his hands? All mere images of the sculptor — no less than delusion, theft, the Caucasus, the vulture, and the whole tragic Prometheia of all those who know? 301 Delusion of the contemplative ones. - Higher human beings distinguish themselves from the lower by seeing and hearing, and thoughtfully seeing and hearing, immeasurably more — and just this distinguishes 9 See above, Book 111, footnote 17, p. 125. 170 Book Four: St Januartus human beings from animals, and the higher animals from the lower. The world becomes ever fuller for someone who grows into the height of humanity; ever more baited hooks to attract his interest are cast his way; the things that stimulate him grow steadily in number, as do the kinds of things that please and displease him — the higher human being always becomes at the same time happier and unhappier. But a delusion remains his constant companion: he thinks himself placed as spectator and /istener before the great visual and acoustic play that is life; he calls his nature contemplative and thereby overlooks the fact that he is also the actual poet and ongoing author of life — that, to be sure, he differs greatly from the actor of this drama, the so-called man of action, but even more so from a mere spectator and festival visitor in front of the stage. As the poet, he certainly possesses vis contemplativa!® and a retrospective view of his work; but at the same time and above all vis creativa,” which the man of action lacks, whatever appearances and universal belief may say. It is we, the thinking-sensing ones, who really and continually make something that is not yet there: the whole perpetually growing world of valuations, colours, weights, perspectives, scales, affirmations, and negations. This poem that we have invented is constantly internalized, drilled, translated into flesh and reality, indeed, into the commonplace, by the so-called practical human beings (our actors). Whatever has va/ue in the present world has it not in itself, according to its nature — nature is always value-less — but has rather been given, granted value, and we were the givers and granters! Only we have created the world that concerns human beings! But precisely this knowledge we lack, and when we catch it for a moment we have forgotten it the next: we misjudge our best power and underestimate ourselves just a bit, we contemplative ones. We are neither as proud nor as happy as we could be. 302 The danger of the happiest. - To have refined senses and a refined taste; to be accustomed to the exquisite and most excellent things of the spirit as one is to the proper and most usual food; to enjoy a strong, bold, audacious soul; to go through life with a calm eye and a firm step, always 10 ‘contemplative power’ 11 ‘creative power’ 171 The Gay Science prepared for the most extreme situations — as for a feast and full of yearning for undiscovered worlds and seas, people, and gods; to hearken to all cheerful music as if brave men, soldiers, seafarers

were perhaps seeking a short rest and merriment there — and in the deepest pleasure of the moment to be overcome by tears and the whole crimson melancholy of the happy: who would not like all of this to be Ais possession, his state! It was the happiness of Homer! The happiness of the one who invented their gods for the Greeks — I mean, his gods for himself! But don't disregard the fact that with this Homeric happiness in one's soul one is also more capable of suffering than any other creature under the sun! Only at this price can one buy the most precious shell hitherto washed ashore by the waves of existence! As its owner, one becomes ever more refined in pain and eventually too refined; in the end, any slight discontentment and disgust was enough to spoil life for Homer. He had been unable to solve a silly little riddle posed to him by some young fishermen!!? Yes, the little riddles are the danger for those who are happiest! 393

Two happy ones. — Truly, despite his youth, this person knows how to improvise life and amazes even the keenest observer — for he never seems to make a mistake even though he constantly plays the riskiest game. It reminds one of those masters of musical improvisation to whose hands the listener would also like to ascribe a divine infallibility even though, like every mortal, they make a mistake here and there. But they are practised and inventive and always ready at any moment to incorporate into the thematic order the most accidental note to which the stroke of a finger or a mood drives them, breathing a beautiful meaning and a soul into an accident. Here is an entirely different person: basically every- thing he wills and plans goes wrong. What occasionally he set his heart on several times brought him to the edge of the abyss and within a hair of destruction; and if he did escape that, it was certainly not just 'with a 12 Some of the ancient biographies of Homer state that at the end of his life he was deeply chagrined — some even say he died of chagrin — because he was unable to solve a riddle put to him by some young fishermen. The riddle: 'What we caught we left behind; what we didn't catch we carry with us.' (Answer: lice. Not having any luck with their fishing, they sat down to delouse each other. The lice they caught, they discarded; those they missed were still on their persons.) See Vita Herodotea, 492-516, Certamen, 321-38, Plutarchi Vita, 62~71 etc. 172 Book Four: St Januarius black eye.' Do you believe he is unhappy about this? He decided long ago not to take his own wishes and plans so seriously. 'If I don't succeed at this,' he says to himself, 'I might succeed at that; and on the whole I don't know whether I should be more grateful towards my failures than towards any success. Was I made to be stubborn and to have a bull's horns? That which constitutes the value and outcome of life for me lies elsewhere; my pride as well as my misery lie elsewhere. I know more about life because I have so often been on the verge of losing it; and precisely therefore do I get more out of life than any of you!' 304 By doing we forgo. — Basically I abhor every morality that says: 'Do not do this! Renounce! Overcome yourself!' But I am well disposed

towards those moralities that impel me to do something again and again from morning till evening, and to dream of it at night, and to think of nothing else than doing this well, as well as J alone can! When one lives that way, one thing after another that does not belong to such a life drops off: without hate or reluctance one sees this take its leave today and that tomorrow, like the yellow leaves that every faint wisp of wind carries off a tree. Or he does not notice that it takes its leave — so sternly is his eye set on its goal, entirely forwards, not sideways, backwards, downwards. ‘What we do should determine what we forgo; in doing we forgo’ — that’s how I like it; that is my *placitum*.’? But I do not want to strive for my impoverishment with open eyes; I do not like negative virtues — virtues whose very essence is negation and self-denial. 395 Self-control. — Those moralists who command man first and above all to gain control of himself thereby afflict him with a peculiar disease, namely, a constant irritability at all natural stirrings and inclinations and as it were a kind of itch. Whatever may henceforth push, pull, beckon, impel him from within or without will always strike this irritable one as endangering his self-control: no longer may he entrust himself to any instinct or free wing-beat; instead he stands there rigidly with a 13 ‘opinion’ 173 The Gay Science defensive posture, armed against himself, with sharp and suspicious eyes, the eternal guardian of his fortress, since he has turned himself into a fortress. Indeed, he can become great this way! But how insufferable he has become to others; how impoverished and cut off from the most beautiful fortuities of the soul! And indeed from all further instruction! For one must be able at times to lose oneself if one wants to learn something from things that we ourselves are not. 306 Stoics and Epicureans. ~ The Epicurean seeks out the situation, the persons, and even the events that suit his extremely sensitive intellectual constitution; he forgoes the rest — that is, almost everything — because it would be too strong and heavy a diet. The Stoic, by contrast, trains himself to swallow stones and worms, glass shards and scorpions without nausea; he wants his stomach to be ultimately insensible to everything the chance of existence pours into him — he brings to mind the Arabian sect of the Assua that one encounters in Algiers: ‘* like these insensitive people, he likes to act out his insensitivity before an invited audience, which is precisely what the Epicurean gladly eschews — for he has his ‘garden’!!> Stoicism may well be advisable for those with whom fate improvises and who live in violent times and depend on impulsive and changeable people. But someone who more or less expects fate to allow him to spin a long thread does well to take an Epicurean orientation; people engaged in work of the spirit have always done so! For it would be the loss of all losses, for them, to forfeit their subtle sensitivity in exchange for a hard Stoic skin with porcupine spines. 397 In favour of criticism. — Something you formerly loved as a truth or a probability now strikes you as an error; you cast it off and believe your reason has made a victory. But maybe

that error was as necessary for you then, when you were still another person — you are always another 4 For further information about this sect see P. J. André, *Contribution a l'étude des confréries musulmanes* (Algiers, 1956), pp. 216ff. 15 Epicurus (see above, Book 1, footnote 34, p. 59, and Book 1v, footnote 4, p. 157), when he was about thirty-five, bought a house in Athens with a garden, setting up there a school of philosophy which came to be known as 'The Garden'. 174 Book Four: St Januarius person — as are all your present 'truths', like a skin that concealed and covered many things you weren't allowed to see yet. It is your new life, not your reason, that has killed that opinion for you: you don't need it any more, and now it collapses and unreason crawls out of it into the light like a worm. When we criticize, we are not doing something arbitrary and impersonal; it is, at least very often, proof that there are living, active forces within us shedding skin. We negate and have to negate because something in us wants to live and affirm itself, something we might not yet know or see! ~ This in favour of criticism. 308 The history of every day. — What is the history of your every day? Consider the habits of which it consists: are they the product of innumerable little cowardices and lazinesses or of your courage and innovative reason? Different as the two cases may be, people could conceivably give you equal praise and you might actually benefit them equally either way. However, praise and benefit and respectability may be enough for those who want merely a good conscience — but not for you who scrupulously examine the inside of things and know about conscience! 309 From the seventh solitude. -One day the wanderer slammed a door shut behind him, came to a halt, and wept. Then he said: "This penchant and passion for what is true, real, non-apparent, certain — how it exasperates me! Why does this gloomy and earnest oppressor follow me of all people! I want to rest, but he won't allow it. How many things seduce me to linger? Everywhere there are Armida's gardens!® for me. Thus ever again I must tear myself away and feel another new bitterness in my heart! Once again I must lift my foot, this tired, wounded foot; and having to do so often makes me cast a wrathful glance back at the most beautiful thing that could not hold me — because it could not hold me!" '6 In the epic poem *Gerusalemme Liberata* (1575) by Torquato Tasso (1544~95), the enchantress Armida has a magic garden into which she entices men. 175 The Gay Science 310 Will and wave. — How greedily this wave is approaching, as if it were trying to reach something! How it crawls with terrifying haste into the inmost crevices of the craggy gorge! It seems to be trying to arrive before someone else; something of value, of great value, seems to be hidden there. - And now it is returning, a bit more slowly but still quite white with excitement — is it disappointed? Has it found what it was seeking? Is it simulating disappointment? — But already another wave is nearing, still more greedily and wildly than the first; and its soul, too, seems full of secrets and the hunger for treasure-digging. That is how the waves live — that

is how we live, we who will — I will say no more. So? You distrust me? You are angry with me, you beautiful monsters? Are you afraid I will divulge your entire secret? Well, be angry with me; raise your dangerous green bodies as high as you can; make a wall between me and the sun — as you are now! Truly, at this moment nothing remains of the world but green dusk and green thunderbolts. Carry on as you want, you high-spirited ones: roar with delight and malice — or dive again, pour your emeralds into the deepest depths, cast your endless white mane of foam and froth over them: everything is fine with me because everything suits you so well, and I love you so for everything — how could I betray you! For — mark my words! — I know you and your secret; I know your kind! After all, you and I are of one kind! After all, you and I have one secret!

311 Refracted light. - One is not always brave; and when one gets tired, one of us, too, is likely one day to lament: ‘It is so hard to hurt people — why is it necessary! What good does it do us to live in seclusion when we don’t want to keep to ourselves what gives offence? Wouldn’t it be more advisable to live in the bustle and to do good to individuals as compensation for the sins that should and must be committed against everyone? To be foolish with fools, vain with the vain, fanatic with the fanatic? Wouldn’t it be fair, given the extravagant degree of deviation on the whole? When I hear of other people’s malice towards me, is not satisfaction the first thing I feel? Quite right! (I seem to be 176 Book Four: St FJanuarius saying to them) I am so little in agreement with you and have so much truth on my side that you might as well have a good day at my expense whenever you can! Here are my faults and mistakes; here is my delusion, my bad taste, my confusion, my tears, my vanity, my owlsh seclusion, my contradictions! Here’s something for you to laugh at! So then laugh and be merry! I am not angry with the law and nature of things that want faults and mistakes to cause merriment! To be sure, there have been “more beautiful” times when one could still, with every moderately new idea, feel so indispensable as to take it out on the street and shout at everyone: “Behold! The kingdom of heaven is at hand!”? I would not miss myself if I were gone. We are all dispensable!’ But as I said, this is not how we think when we are brave; then we don’t think about that.

312 My dog. — I have named my pain and call it ‘dog’ — it’s just as faithful, just as obtrusive and shameless, just as entertaining, just as clever as every other dog — and I can scold it and take my bad moods out on it the way others do with their dogs, servants, and wives.

313 No image of torment. — I want to follow Raphael’s example and never paint another image of torment. There are enough sublime things; one does not have to seek sublimity where it lives in sisterhood with cruelty; anyway, my ambition would find no satisfaction if I wanted to make myself a sublime torturer.

314 New domestic animals. — I want my lion and eagle around so that I can always have hints and forebodings to know how great or small my strength is. Must I look down on them today and

fear them? And will the hour return when they look up at me — in fear? 17
 Matthew 4:17 177 The Gay Science 315 On the last hour. — Storms are my
 danger: will I have my storm of which I perish, as Cromwell perished of his
 storm? Or will I go out like a light that no wind blows out, but that grew tired
 and sated with itself — a burned-out light? Or finally: will I blow myself out lest
 I burn out? — 316 Prophetic human beings. — You are not sensible to the fact
 that prophetic human beings are full of suffering; you simply think they have
 been granted a beautiful ‘gift’ that you yourselves probably would like to have
 — but I will express myself in a parable. How animals can suffer from electricity
 in the air and clouds! We see how certain species, for example, monkeys, have a
 prophetic insight about the weather (as one can observe even in Europe — and
 not only in zoos, but also on Gibraltar). But we don’t think of the fact that for
 them, their pains are prophets for them! When under the influence of an
 approaching, as yet far from visible cloud a strong positive electrical charge
 suddenly turns into negative electricity and a change in the weather is impending,
 these animals act as if an enemy were approaching and prepare for defence or
 escape. Most often they crawl into hiding — they don’t see bad weather as
 weather, but as an enemy whose hand they can already /feel! 317 Retrospection.
 — While we are living each phase of our lives we rarely recognize its true
 pathos, but always see it as the only state that is now possible for us and
 reasonable and — to use some words and a distinction of the Greeks —
 thoroughly an ethos and not a pathos. Today a few notes of music called back to
 my memory a winter and a house and a most solitary life, as well as the feeling I
 lived with: I thought I could continue to live that way forever. But now I
 understand that it was pathos and passion throughout, 18 A lasting state of
 character, not a temporary state of being affected one way or another 178 Book
 Four: St Januartus comparable to this painful, courageous music which brings
 certain solace — one is not allowed to possess such things for years at a time,
 how much the less for eternities: they would make one too ‘overworldly’ for this
 planet. 318 Wisdom in pain. — There is as much wisdom in pain as in pleasure:
 like pleasure, pain is one of the prime species-preserving forces. If it weren’t, it
 would have perished long ago: that it hurts is no argument against it — it is its
 essence. In pain I hear the captain’s command: ‘Pull in the sails!’ The hardy
 seafarer ‘Man’ must have learned to adjust the sails in a thousand ways;
 otherwise he would have gone under too quickly and the ocean would have
 swallowed him too soon. We have to know how to live with reduced energy, too:
 as soon as pain sounds its safety signal, it is time for such a reduction — some
 great danger, some storm is approaching, and we do well to ‘inflate ourselves’ as
 little as possible. True, there are people who hear exactly the opposite command
 when great pain approaches and who never look as proud, bellicose, and happy
 as when a storm is nearing — yes, pain itself gives them their greatest moments!

They are the heroic human beings, the great pain- bringers of humanity, those few or rare ones who need the same apology as pain itself — and truly, they should not be denied this! They are eminently species-preserving and species-enhancing forces, if only because they resist comfort and do not hide their nausea at this type of happiness. 319 As interpreters of our experiences. - One type of honesty has been alien to all religion-founders and such: they have not made their experi- erices a matter of conscience for their knowledge. ‘What did I really experience? What was going on inside and around me? Was my reason bright enough? Was my will turned against all deceptions of the senses and stalwart in warding off the fantastic?? None of them has asked such questions. Even today, none of our dear religious ones asks them; rather, they have a thirst for things that are contrary to reason and do not want to make it too hard for themselves to quench it —~ so 179 The Gay Science they experience ‘miracles’ and ‘rebirths’ and hear the voices of the angels! But we, we others, we reason-thirsty ones, want to face our experiences as sternly as we would a scientific experiment, hour by hour, day by day! We want to be our own experiments and guinea- pigs. 320 On meeting again. — A.: Do I still understand you rightly? You are searching? Where is your corner and star within the real world? Where can you lie down in the sun so that an abundance of well-being comes to you, too, and your existence justifies itself? Let everyone do that for himself — you seem to me to be saying — and let everyone put out of his mind generalities and worries about others and about society! B: I want more than that; I am no seeker. I want to create for myself a sun of my own. 321 New caution. — Let’s stop thinking so much about punishing, reproaching, and improving! We rarely change an individual; and should we succeed, something else may have been accomplished, unnoticed: we may have been changed through him! Let’s rather make sure our own influence on all that is to come balances and outweighs his influence! Let’s not struggle in a direct fight, which is what reproaching, punishing, and desiring to improve amount to. Let’s rather raise ourselves that much higher. Let us give our own example ever more brilliant colours! Let us darken the others through our light! No — let’s not become darker on their account, like those who punish and are dissatisfied! Let’s sooner step aside! Let us look away! 322 Parable. — Those thinkers in whom all stars move in cyclical orbits are not the deepest; he who looks into himself as into a vast space and bears galaxies within also knows how irregular galaxies are; they lead into the chaos and labyrinth of existence. 180 Book Four: St Januarius 323 Luck in fate — Fate bestows on us the greatest distinction when it has let us fight for a time on our opponents’ side. Thus we are predestined for a great victory. 324 In media vita.’? — No, life has not disappointed me. Rather, I find it truer, more desirable and mysterious every year — ever since the day the great liberator overcame me: the thought that life could be an experi- ment for the knowledge-seeker — not a duty, not a disaster, not a

deception! And knowledge itself: let it be something else to others, like a bed to rest on or the way to one, or a diversion or a form of idleness; to me it is a world of dangers and victories in which heroic feelings also have their dance- and playgrounds. 'Life as a means to knowledge' — with this principle in one's heart one can not only live bravely but also /ive gaily and laugh gaily! And who would know how to laugh and live well who did not first have a good understanding of war and victory? 325 What belongs to greatness - Who will attain something great if he does not feel in himself the power to inflict great pain? Being able to suffer is the least; weak women and even slaves often achieve mastery at that. But not to perish of inner distress and uncertainty when one inflicts great suffering and hears the cry of this suffering — that is great; that belongs to greatness. 326 Soul-doctors and pain. — All preachers of morals, and all theologians, share one bad habit: they all try to talk people into thinking they are in a very bad way and need some severe, final, radical cure. And since humanity has for centuries far too eagerly lent its ear to these doctrines, something of this superstition of being very badly off has finally stuck, so that they 19 Gn mid-life' 181 The Gay Science are now only too ready to sigh and find nothing good in life and make sad faces together, as if life were really quite hard to endure. In reality, they are uninhibitedly sure of and in love with their lives, and are full of innumerable wiles and tricks to get rid of unpleasantness and extract the thorn of pain and misfortune. Talk of pain and misfortune always strikes me as exaggerated, as if it were a matter of good manners to exaggerate here while deliberately keeping quiet about the fact that there are innumerable palliatives against pain, such as an aesthetics, or the feverish haste of thoughts, or a restful position of the body, or good and bad memories, intentions, hopes, and many types of pride and sympathy, which have nearly the same effect as anaesthesia — and at the highest degrees of pain, unconsciousness automatically takes over. We know quite well how to trickle sweets onto our bitternesses, especially onto the soul's bitternesses; we find aid in our boldness and sublimity, as well as in the nobler deliriums of submission and resignation. A loss is a loss for barely an hour; somehow it also brings us a gift from heaven — new strength, for example, or at least a new opportunity for strength! What fantasies about the inner 'miseries' of evil persons the preachers of morals have concocted! How they have even /ied to us about the unhappiness of passionate people! Yes, 'lied' is here the proper term: they knew very well about the superabundant happiness of this type of person, but kept a deathly silence about it, since it constituted a refutation of their theory on which happiness arises only with the annihilation of passion and the silencing of the will! Finally, concerning these soul-doctors' prescrip- tion and their praise for a severe, radical cure, one may ask: is our life really so painful and burdensome that it would be advantageous for us to trade it for a fossilized Stoic way of life? Things are not bad enough for us that they have

to be bad for us in the Stoic style! 327 Taking seriously. — For most people, the intellect is an awkward, gloomy, creaking machine that is hard to start: when they want to work with this machine and think well, they call it ‘taking the matter seriously’ — oh, how taxing good thinking must be for them! The lovely human beast seems to lose its good mood when it thinks well; it becomes ‘serious’! And ‘where laughter and gaiety are found, thinking is good for nothing’ 182 Book Four: St Januarius — that is the prejudice of this serious beast against all ‘gay science’. Well then, let us prove it a prejudice! 328 To harm stupidity. — Surely the creed concerning the reprehensibility of egoism, preached so stubbornly and with so much conviction, has on the whole harmed egoism (to the advantage of, as I will repeat a hundred times, the herd instincts!) — above all, by depriving egoism of its good conscience and telling us to seek in it the true source of all unhappiness. ‘Your selfishness is the reason your life is miserable (Unheil)? — that was preached for millennia and, as I said, harmed selfishness and deprived it of much spirit, much cheerfulness, much inventiveness, much beauty; it made selfishness stupid and ugly and poisoned it! Ancient philosophy, by contrast, taught a quite different main source of misery (Unheil): from Socrates onwards these thinkers never tired of preaching, ‘Your thoughtlessness and stupidity, your way of living according to the rule, your subordination to the opinion of your neighbour is the reason why you so seldom achieve happiness — we thinkers are, as thinkers, the happiest.’ Let us not decide here whether this sermon against stupidity had better reasons on its side than the sermon against selfishness; what is certain, however, is that it deprived stupidity of its good conscience — these philosophers harmed stupidity. 329 Leisure and idleness. - There is something of the American Indian, something of the savagery peculiar to the Indian blood, in the way the Americans strive for gold; and their breathless haste in working — the true vice of the new world — is already starting to spread to old Europe, making it savage and covering it with a most odd mindlessness. Already one is ashamed of keeping still; long reflection almost gives people a bad conscience. One thinks with a watch in hand, as one eats lunch with an eye on the financial pages — one lives like someone who might always ‘miss out on something’. ‘Rather do anything than nothing’ — even this principle is a cord to strangle all culture and all higher taste. Just as all forms are visibly being destroyed by the haste of the workers, so, too, is 183 The Gay Science the feeling for form itself, the ear and eye for the melody of movements. The proof of this lies in the crude obviousness which is universally demanded in all situations in which people want for once to be honest with others — in their relations with friends, women, relatives, children, teachers, students, leaders, and princes: one no longer has time and energy for ceremony, for civility with detours, for esprit in conversation, and in general for any otium”° For life in a hunt for profit constantly forces people to expend their spirit to the point of

exhaustion in continual pretence or out-smarting or forestalling others: the true virtue today is doing something in less time than someone else. And thus hours in which honesty is allowed are rare; during them, however, one is tired and wants not only to 'let oneself go' but also to lay oneself down and stretch oneself out unceremoniously to one's full length and breadth. This is the way people now write letters, the style and spirit of which will always be the true 'sign of the times'. If sociability and the arts still offer any delight, it is the kind of delight that overworked slaves make for themselves. How frugal our educated and uneducated have become concerning 'joy'! How they are becoming increasingly suspicious of all joy! More and more, work gets all good conscience on its side; the desire for joy already calls itself a 'need to recuperate' and is starting to be ashamed of itself. 'One owes it to one's health' — that is what one says when caught on an excursion in the countryside. Soon we may well reach the point where one can't give in to the desire for a *vita contemplativa*! (that is, taking a walk with ideas and friends) without self-contempt and a bad conscience. Well, formerly it was the other way around: work was afflicted with a bad conscience. A person of good family concealed the fact that he worked if need compelled him to work. The slave worked under the pressure of the feeling that he was doing something contemptible: 'doing' was itself contemptible. 'Nobility and honour are attached solely to *otium* and *bellum*'? — that was the ancient prejudice! 330 Applause. — A thinker needs no applause and clapping of hands provided he is sure of his own clapping of hands; he cannot do without that. Are 20 'Jeisure' 21 'the contemplative life' 22 war? 184 Book Four: St Januarius there people who can dispense with that, too, and altogether with every kind of applause? I doubt it; and Tacitus, who did not slander the wise, said even of the wisest of men: *quando etiam sapientibus gloriae cupido novissima excutitur?* — which for him means never. 331 Better deaf than deafened — Formerly one wanted to be talked about; that is no longer enough, since the market has grown too large — only a shout will do. As a result, even good voices shout themselves down, and the best goods are offered by hoarse voices; without the vendors' cry and hoarseness there is no longer any genius. That is, to be sure, a bad epoch for a thinker; he must learn how to find his own quietude even between two noises, and pretend he is deaf until he really is. As long as he has not learned this, he runs the risk of going to pieces from impatience and headaches. 332 The evil hour. ~ Every philosopher has probably had an evil hour when he thought: What do I matter if people don't accept my bad arguments, too? And then some malicious little bird flew over him and chirped: 'What do you matter? What do you matter?' 333 What knowing means. — *Non ridere, non lugere, neque detestari, sed intelligere!* says Spinoza as simply and sublimely as is his wont. Yet in the final analysis, what is this *intelligere* other than the way we become sensible of the other three? A result of the different and conflicting impulses to

laugh, lament, and curse? Before knowledge is possible, each of these impulses must first have presented its one-sided view of the thing or event; then comes the fight between these one-sided views, and occasionally out of it a mean, an appeasement, a concession to all 23 ‘since the desire for fame is the last thing even the wise are able to rid themselves of’; Tacitus (first century AD) *Histories* 1v.6 2+ ‘not to laugh at or lament over or despise, but to understand’; Spinoza (see above, Book 1, footnote 28, p. 55) *Ethica*, Book 111, Praefatio 185 The Gay Science three sides, a kind of justice and contract; for in virtue of justice and a contract all these impulses can assert and maintain themselves in existence and each can finally feel it is in the right vis-a-vis all the others. Since only the ultimate reconciliation scenes and final accounts of this long process rise to consciousness, we suppose that intelligere must be something conciliatory, just, and good, something essentially opposed to the instincts, when in fact it is only a certain behaviour of the drives towards one another. For the longest time, conscious thought was considered thought itself; only now does the truth dawn on us that by far the greatest part of our mind’s activity proceeds unconscious and unfelt; but I think these drives which here fight each other know very well how to make themselves felt by and how to hurt each other. This may well be the source of that great and sudden exhaustion that afflicts all thinkers (it is the exhaustion of the battlefield). Indeed, there may be many hidden instances for Aeroism in our warring depths, but certainly nothing divine, eternally resting in itself, as Spinoza supposed. Conscious thought, especially that of the philosopher, is the least vigorous and therefore also the relatively mildest and calmest type of thought; and thus precisely philosophers are most easily led astray about the nature of knowledge. 334 One must learn to love. — This happens to us in music: first one must learn to hear a figure and melody at all, to detect and distinguish it, to isolate and delimit it as a life in itself; then one needs effort and good will to stand it despite its strangeness; patience with its appearance and expression, and kindheartedness about its oddity. Finally comes a moment when we are used to it; when we expect it; when we sense that we’d miss it if it were missing; and now it continues relentlessly to compel and enchant us until we have become its humble and enraptured lovers, who no longer want anything better from the world than it and it again. But this happens to us not only in music: it is in just this way that we have learned to love everything we now love. We are always rewarded in the end for our good will, our patience, our fair-mindedness and gentleness with what is strange, as it gradually casts off its veil and presents itself as a new and indescribable beauty. That is its thanks for our hospitality. Even he who loves himself will 186 Book Four: St FJanuarius have learned it this way — there is no other way. Love, too, must be learned. 335 Long live physics! ~ So, how many people know how to observe? And of these few, how many to observe themselves? ‘Everyone is

farthest from himself'?⁵ — every person who is expert at scrutinizing the inner life of others knows this to his own chagrin; and the saying, 'Know thyself', addressed to human beings by a god, is near to malicious.*© That self-observation is in such a bad state, however, is most clearly confirmed by the way in which nearly everyone speaks of the nature of a moral act — that quick, willing, convinced, talkative manner, with its look, its smile, its obliging eagerness! People seem to be wanting to say to you, 'But my dear fellow, that is precisely my subject! You are directing your question to the person who is competent to answer it: there is, as it happens, nothing I am wiser about. So: when man judges "that is right" and infers "hence it must come about!" and then does what he thus has recognized to be right and described as necessary — then the nature of his act is moral! But, my friend, you are speaking of three acts instead of one: even the judgement 'that is right', for example, is an act. Wouldn't it be possible for a person to make a judgement in a way that would be moral or immoral? Why do you take this and specifically this to be right? 'Because my conscience tells me so; conscience never speaks immorally, since it determines what is to count as moral!' But why do you listen to the words of your conscience? And what gives you the right to consider such a judgement true and infallible? For this belief — is there no conscience? Do you know nothing of an intellectual conscience? A conscience behind your 'conscience'? Your judgement, 'that is right' has a prehistory in your drives, inclinations, aversions, experiences, and what you have failed to experience; you have to ask, 'how did it emerge there?' and then also, 'what is really impelling me to listen to it?' You can listen to its commands like a good soldier who heeds the command of his officer. Or like a woman who loves the one who commands. Or like a flatterer and coward who fears the commander. Or like a fool who

5 Reversal of common German expression 'Everyone is closest to himself'; cf. *Andria* 1v .i by the Roman comedy-writer Terence (second century BC). 26 Motto inscribed over the entrance to the oracle of Apollo at Delphi 187 The Gay Science obeys because he can think of no objection. In short, there are a hundred ways to listen to your conscience. But that you hear this or that judgement as the words of conscience, i.e. that you feel something to be right may have its cause in your never having thought much about yourself and in your blindly having accepted what has been labelled right since your childhood; or in the fact that fulfilling your duties has so far brought you bread and honours — and you consider it right because it appears to you as your own 'condition of existence' (and that you have a right to existence seems irrefutable to you). For all that, the firmness of your moral judgement could be evidence of your personal wretchedness, of lack of a personality; your 'moral strength' might have its source in your stubbornness — or in your inability to envisage new ideals. And, briefly, had you reflected more subtly, observed better, and studied more, you would never continue to call this

‘duty’ of yours and this ‘conscience’ of yours duty and conscience. Your insight into how such things as moral judgements could ever have come into existence would spoil these emotional words for you, as other emotional words, for example, ‘sin’, ‘salvation of the soul’, and ‘redemption’ have been spoiled for you. And now don’t bring up the categorical imperative, my friend! The term tickles my ear and makes me laugh despite your very serious presence. I am reminded of old Kant, who helped himself to (erschlichen) the ‘thing in itself’ — another very ridiculous thing! — and was punished for this when the ‘categorical imperative’ crept into (beschlichen) his heart and made him stray back to ‘God’, ‘soul’, ‘freedom’, ‘immortality’, like a fox who strays back into his cage. Yet it had been Ais strength and cleverness that had broken open the cage!’ What? You admire the categorical imperative within you? This ‘firmness’ of your so-called moral judgement? This absoluteness of the feeling, ‘here everyone must judge as I do’? Rather admire your selfishness here! And the blindness, pettiness, and simplicity of your selfishness! For it is selfish to consider one’s own judgement a universal law, and this selfishness is blind, petty, 27 In the Critique of Pure Reason (1781) Kant argued that the great concepts of traditional speculation — God, the soul, freedom — did not designate objects about which it was even in principle possible for us to know anything. This seemed to spell the end of traditional metaphysics and theology. In the Critique of Practical Reason (1788), however, Kant seemed to argue that the morality required us to accept as ‘postulates of pure practical reason’ a number of principles such as the existence of God and the continuation of some form of life after death. This was thought by many to reintroduce the possibility of a version of the theology it had been the great glory of his earlier work to terminate. “The categorical imperative’ is Kant’s fundamental principle of morality. 188 Book Four: St Januarius and simple because it shows that you haven’t yet discovered yourself or created for yourself an ideal of your very own — for this could never be someone else’s, let alone everyone’s, everyone’s! No one who judges, ‘in this case everyone would have to act like this’ has yet taken five steps towards self-knowledge. For he would then know that there neither are nor can be actions that are all the same; that every act ever performed was done in an altogether unique and unrepeatable way, and that this will be equally true of every future act; that all prescriptions of action (even the most inward and subtle rules of all moralities so far) relate only to their rough exterior; that these prescriptions may yield an appearance of sameness, but only just an appearance; that as one observes or recollects any action, it is and remains impenetrable; that our opinions about ‘good’ and ‘noble’ and ‘great’ can never be proven true by our actions because every act is unknowable; that our opinions, valuations, and tables of what is good are certainly some of the most powerful levers in the machinery of our actions, but that in each case, the law of its mechanism is unprovable. Let us therefore /imit

ourselves to the purification of our opinions and value judgements and to the creation of tables of what is good that are new and all our own: let us stop brooding over the 'moral value of our actions'! Yes, my friends, it is time to feel nauseous about some people's moral chatter about others. Sitting in moral judgement should offend our taste. Let us leave such chatter and such bad taste to those who have nothing to do but drag the past a few steps further through time and who never live in the present — that is, to the many, the great majority! We, however, want to become who we are — human beings who are new, unique, incomparable, who give themselves laws, who create themselves! To that end we must become the best students and discoverers of everything lawful and necessary in the world: we must become physicists in order to be creators in this sense — while hitherto all valuations and ideals have been built on ignorance of physics or in contradiction to it. So, long live physics! And even more long live what compels us to it — our honesty! 336 Nature's stinginess. — Why has nature been so miserly towards humans that it did not allow them to shine — one more brightly, the other less so, each according to his inner magnitude of light? Why are great human 189 The Gay Science beings not as beautifully visible in their own rising and setting as the sun? How much more unambiguous this would make life among men! 337 The 'humanity' of the future. ~ When I view this age with the eyes of a distant age, I can find nothing odder in present-day man than his peculiar virtue and disease called 'the sense for history'. This is the beginning of something completely new and strange in history: if one gave this seed a few centuries and more, it might ultimately become a wonderful growth with an equally wonderful smell that could make our old earth more agreeable to inhabit. We present-day humans are just beginning to form the chain of a very powerful future feeling, link by link — we hardly know what we are doing. It seems to us almost as if we are dealing not with a new feeling but with a decrease in all old feelings: the sense for history is still something so poor and cold, and many are struck by it as by a frost and made even poorer and colder by it. To others it appears as the sign of old age creeping up, and they see our planet as a melancholy sick man who chronicles his youth in order to forget his present condition. Indeed, that is one colour of this new feeling: he who is able to feel the history of man altogether as his own history feels in a monstrous generalization all the grief of the invalid thinking of health, of the old man thinking of the dreams of his youth, of the lover robbed of his beloved, of the martyr whose ideal is perishing, of the hero on the eve after a battle that decided nothing but brought him wounds and the loss of a friend. But to bear and to be able to bear this monstrous sum of all kinds of grief and still be the hero who, on the second day of battle, greets dawn and his fortune as a person whose horizon stretches millennia before and behind him, as the dutiful heir to all the nobility of past spirit, as the most aristocratic of old nobles and at the same time the first of

a new nobility the likes of which no age has ever seen or dreamt: to take this upon one's soul — the oldest, the newest, losses, hopes, conquests, victories of humanity. To finally take all this in one soul and compress it into one feeling ~ this would surely have to produce a happiness unknown to humanity so far: a divine happiness full of power and love, full of tears and laughter, a happiness which, like the sun in the evening, continually draws on its inexhaustible riches, giving them away and pouring them into the sea, a 190 Book Four: St Januarius happiness which, like the evening sun, feels richest when even the poorest fisherman is rowing with a golden oar! This divine feeling would then be called — humanity! 338 The will to suffer and those who feel compassion. — Is it good for you yourselves to be above all else compassionate persons? And is it good for those who suffer if you are compassionate? But let us leave the first question unanswered for a moment. What we most deeply and most personally suffer from is incomprehensible and inaccessible to nearly everyone else; here we are hidden from our nearest, even if we eat from the same pot. But whenever we are noticed to be suffering, our suffering is superficially construed; it is the essence of the feeling of compassion that it strips the suffering of what is truly personal: our 'benefactors' diminish our worth and our will more than our enemies do. In most cases of beneficence toward those in distress there is something offensive in the intellectual frivolity with which the one who feels compassion plays the role of fate: he knows nothing of the whole inner sequence and interconnection that spells misfortune for me or for you! The entire economy of my soul and the balance effected by 'misfortune', the breaking open of new springs and needs, the healing of old wounds, the shedding of entire periods of the past — all such things that can be involved in misfortune do not concern the dear compassionate one: they want to help and have no thought that there is a personal necessity of misfortune; that terrors, deprivations, impoverishments, midnights, adventures, risks, and blunders are as necessary for me and you as their opposites; indeed, to express myself mystically, that the path to one's own heaven always leads through the voluptuousness of one's own hell. No, they know nothing of that: the 'religion of compassion' (or 'the heart') commands them to help, and they believe they have helped best when they have helped most quickly! Should you adherents to this religion really have the same attitude towards yourselves that you have towards your fellow men; should you refuse to let your suffering lie on you even for an hour and instead constantly prevent all possible misfortune ahead of time; should you experience suffering and displeasure as evil, hateful, deserving of annihilation, as a defect of existence, then you have besides your religion of pity also another religion in your 191 The Gay Science hearts; and the latter is perhaps the mother of the former — the religion of snug cosiness. Oh, how little do you know of the happiness of man, you comfortable and good-natured ones! For happiness and misfortune (Glick und Unglück) are two

siblings and twins who either grow up together or — as with you — remain small together! But now back to the first question. How is it possible to keep to one's own path! Some clamour is constantly calling us aside; rarely does our eye see something there that does not make it necessary to drop our own occupation instantly and spring to assistance. I know, there are a hundred decent and praiseworthy ways of losing myself from my path, and, verily, highly 'moral' ways! Yes, the moral teacher of compassion even goes so far as to hold that precisely this and only this is moral — to lose one's own way like this in order to help a neighbour. I, too, know with certainty that I need only to expose myself to the sight of real distress and I, too, am lost! If a suffering friend said to me, 'Look, I am about to die; please promise to die with me', I would promise it; likewise, the sight of a small mountain tribe fighting for its freedom would make me offer my hand and my life — for once to choose bad examples, for good reasons. Yes, there is a secret seduction even in all these things which arouse compassion and cry out for help, for our own way is so hard and demanding and so far from love and gratitude of others that we are by no means reluctant to escape from it, from it and our ownmost conscience — and take refuge in the conscience of the others and in the lovely temple of the 'religion of compassion'. As soon as any war breaks out, precisely the noblest men in the population immediately begin to experience a delight which is, to be sure, kept secret: they throw themselves rapturously into the new danger of death because it seems to offer them that long-desired permission — the permission to deviate from their goal; war offers them a detour to suicide, but a detour with a good conscience. And, although I will keep quiet here about some things, I do not wish to keep quiet about my morality, which tells me: Live in seclusion so that you are able to live for yourself! Live in ignorance of what seems most important to your age! Lay at least the skin of three hundred years between you and today! And let the clamour of today, the noise of war and revolutions, be but a murmur to you. You will also want to help — but only those whose distress you properly understand because they share with you one suffering and one hope — your friends — and only in the way you help 192 Book Four: St Januarius yourself: I want to make them braver, more persevering, simpler, more full of gaiety. I want to teach them what is today understood by so few, least of all by these preachers of compassion (Mitleiden): to share not pain, but joy (Mitfreude)! 339 Vita femina."[®] — Not even all knowledge and all good will suffice for seeing the ultimate beauties of a work; it requires the rarest of lucky accidents for the clouds that veil the peaks to lift for us momentarily and for the sun to shine on them. Not only must we stand in just the right spot to see this, but our own soul, too, must itself have pulled the veil from its heights and must have been in need of some external expression and parable, as if it needed a hold in order to retain control of itself. But so rarely does all of this coincide that I am inclined to believe that the highest peaks of

everything good, be it work, deed, humanity, or nature, have so far remained hidden and covered from the majority and even from the best. But what does unveil itself for us unveils itself for us only once! The Greeks, to be sure, prayed: ‘Everything beautiful twice and thrice!’”? Indeed, they had good reason to summon the gods, for ungodly reality gives us the beautiful either never or only once! I mean to say that the world is brimming with beautiful things but nevertheless poor, very poor in beautiful moments and in the unveilings of those things. But perhaps that is the strongest magic of life: it is covered by a veil of beautiful possibilities, woven with threads of gold — promising, resisting, bashful, mocking, compassionate, and seductive. Yes, life is a woman! 340 The dying Socrates.*° — I admire the courage and wisdom of Socrates in everything he did, said — and did not say. This mocking, love-sick monster and pried piper of Athens, who made the most audacious youths of Athens tremble and sob, was not only the wisest chatterer of all time; he was equally great in silence. I wish he had remained silent also in 28 “Life — a woman” 29 Plato, *Gorgias* 498c and *Philebus* 59e—60a 39 See also above, § 36, p. 54. 193 The *Gay Science* the last moments of his life — perhaps he would then belong to a still higher order of minds. Whether it was death or the poison or piety or malice — something loosened his tongue and he said: ‘O Crito, I owe Asclepius a rooster.’ This ridiculous and terrible ‘last word’ means for those who have ears: ‘O Crito, life is a disease.’>! Is it possible that a man like him, who had lived cheerfully and like a soldier in plain view of everyone, was a pessimist? He had merely kept a cheerful demeanour while all his life hiding his ultimate judgement, his inmost feeling! Socrates, Socrates suffered from life! And then he still avenged himself — with this veiled, gruesome, pious, and blasphemous saying. Did a Socrates really need revenge? Was there one ounce too little magnanimity in his overabundant virtue? — O friends! We must overcome even the Greeks! 341 The heaviest weight. — What if some day or night a demon were to steal into your loneliest loneliness and say to you: ‘This life as you now live it and have lived it you will have to live once again and innumerable times again; and there will be nothing new in it, but every pain and every joy and every thought and sigh and everything unspeakably small or great in your life must return to you, all in the same succession and sequence — even this spider and this moonlight between the trees, and even this moment and I myself. The eternal hourglass of existence is turned over again and again, and you with it, speck of dust!’ Would you not throw yourself down and gnash your teeth and curse the demon who spoke thus? Or have you once experienced a tremendous moment when you would have answered him: ‘You are a god, and never have I heard anything more divine.’ If this thought gained power over you, as you are it would transform and possibly crush you; the question in each and every thing, ‘Do you want this again and innumerable times again?’ would lie on your actions as the heaviest weight! Or

how well disposed would you have 31 See Plato, *Phaedo* 116—18, esp. 118a.5—8. Asclepius was the god of healing and a rooster would have been a usual thank-offering to him from someone whom he had cured of an illness. Nietzsche's interpretation of what Socrates said was not standard in the ancient world, and became common only in the Renaissance. It is rejected by some modern scholars.

194 Book Four: St Januarius to become to yourself and to life to long for nothing more fervently than for this ultimate eternal confirmation and seal?

342 Incipit tragoedia. — When Zarathustra*? was thirty years old, he left his homeland and Lake Urmi and went into the mountains. There he enjoyed his spirit and solitude, and did not tire of that for ten years. But at last his heart changed — and one morning he arose with rosy dawn, stepped before the sun, and spoke to it thus: 'You great heavenly body! What would your happiness be if you did not have those for whom you shine! For ten years you have climbed up to my cave; without me, my eagle, and my snake, you would have become tired of your light and of this road; but we awaited you every morning, relieved you of your overabundance, and blessed you for it. Behold, I am sick of my wisdom, like a bee that has collected too much honey; I need outstretched hands; I would like to give away and distribute until the wise among humans once again enjoy their folly and the poor once again their riches. For that I must step into the depths, as you do in the evening when you go behind the sea and bring light even to the underworld, you over-rich heavenly body! Like you I must go under, as it is called by the human beings to whom I want to descend. So bless me then, you calm eye that can look without envy upon all-too-great happiness! Bless the cup that wants to overflow in order that the water may flow golden from it and everywhere carry the reflection of your bliss! Behold, this cup wants to become empty again, and Zarathustra wants to become human again.' Thus began Zarathustra's going under. 32 'The tragedy begins'. At this point, on completing Book iv, Nietzsche went on to write *Also Sprach Zarathustra* (Thus Spoke Zarathustra), the most prophetic in style among his philosophical works, in 1883-5. He added Book v to *The Gay Science* in 1887. 33 Nietzsche takes the name from that of the Persian religious thinker of the seventh/sixth century BC who propagated a strongly dualistic doctrine, sharply distinguishing between good and evil.

195 Book Five We Fearless Ones Carcasse, tu trembles? Tu tremblerais bien davantage, si tu savais ou je te mène. Turenne 'Carcass, you tremble? You'd tremble even more if you knew where I'm taking you.' Henri de Latour d'Auvergne, Vicomte de Turenne (1611~75) was one of the most successful generals of the French King Louis XIV.

Book Five: We Fearless Ones

343 How to understand our cheerfulness. - The greatest recent event — that 'God is dead'; that the belief in the Christian God has become unbelievable — is already starting to cast its first shadow over Europe. To those few at least whose eyes — or the suspicion in whose eyes is strong and subtle enough for this

spectacle, some kind of sun seems to have set; some old deep trust turned into doubt: to them, our world must appear more autumnal, more mistrustful, stranger, 'older'. But in the main one might say: for many people's power of comprehension, the event is itself far too great, distant, and out of the way even for its tidings to be thought of as having arrived yet. Even less may one suppose many to know at all what this event really means — and, now that this faith has been undermined, how much must collapse because it was built on this faith, leaned on it, had grown into it — for example, our entire European morality. This long, dense succession of demolition, destruction, down- fall, upheaval that now stands ahead: who would guess enough of it today to play the teacher and herald of this monstrous logic of horror, the prophet of deep darkness and an eclipse of the sun the like of which has probably never before existed on earth? Even we born guessers of riddles who are so to speak on a lookout at the top of the mountain, posted between today and tomorrow and stretched in the contradiction between today and tomorrow, we firstlings and premature births of the next century, to whom the shadows that must soon envelop Europe really should have become apparent by now — why is it that even we look forward to this darkening without any genuine involvement and above all without worry and fear for ourselves? Are we perhaps still not too influenced by the most immediate consequences of this event — and these immediate consequences, the consequences for ourselves, are the opposite of what one might expect — not at all sad and gloomy, but much more like a new and barely describable type of light, happiness, relief, amusement, encouragement, dawn . . . Indeed, at hearing the news that 'the old god is dead', we philosophers and 'free spirits' feel illuminated by a new dawn; our heart overflows with gratitude, amazement, forebodings, expectation — finally the horizon seems clear again, even if not bright; finally our ships may set out again, set out to face any danger; every daring of the lover of knowledge is allowed again; the sea, our sea, lies open again; maybe there has never been such an 'open sea'. 199 *The Gay Science* 344

In what way we, too, are still pious. — In science, convictions have no right to citizenship, as one says with good reason: only when they decide to step down to the modesty of a hypothesis, a tentative experimental standpoint, a regulative fiction, may they be granted admission and even a certain value in the realm of knowledge — though always with the restriction that they remain under police supervision, under the police of mistrust. But doesn't this mean, on closer consideration, that a conviction is granted admission to science only when it ceases to be a conviction? Wouldn't the cultivation of the scientific spirit begin when one permitted oneself no more convictions? That is probably the case; only we need still ask: in order that this cultivation begin, must there not be some prior conviction — and indeed one so authoritative and unconditional that it sacrifices all other convictions to itself? We see that science, too, rests on a faith;

there is simply no ‘presuppositionless’ science. The question whether truth is necessary must get an answer in advance, the answer ‘yes’, and moreover this answer must be so firm that it takes the form of the statement, the belief, the conviction: ‘Nothing is more necessary than truth; and in relation to it, everything else has only secondary value.’ This unconditional will to truth — what is it? Is it the will not to let oneself be deceived? Is it the will not to deceive? For the will to truth could be interpreted in this second way, too — if ‘I do not want to deceive myself’ is included as a special case under the generalization ‘I do not want to deceive.’ But why not deceive? But why not allow oneself to be deceived? Note that the reasons for the former lie in a completely different area from those for the latter: one does not want to let oneself be deceived because one assumes it is harmful, dangerous, disastrous to be deceived; in this sense science would be a long-range prudence, caution, utility, and to this one could justifiably object: How so? Is it really less harmful, dangerous, disastrous not to want to let oneself be deceived? What do you know in advance about the character of existence to be able to decide whether the greater advantage is on the side of the unconditionally distrustful or of the unconditionally trusting? But should both be necessary — a lot of trust as well as a lot of mistrust — then where might science get the ! See Kant, Critique of Pure Reason B 670, 799. 200 Book Five: We Fearless Ones unconditional belief or conviction on which it rests, that truth is more important than anything else, than every other conviction? Precisely this conviction could never have originated if truth and untruth had constantly made it clear they they were both useful, as they are. So, the faith in science, which after all undeniably exists, cannot owe its origin to such a calculus of utility; rather it must have originated in spite of the fact that the disutility and dangerousness of ‘the will to truth’ or ‘truth at any price’ is proved to it constantly. ‘At any price’: we understand this well enough once we have offered and slaughtered one faith after another on this altar! Consequently, ‘will to truth’ does not mean ‘I do not want to let myself be deceived’ but — there is no alternative — ‘I will not deceive, not even myself’; and with that we stand on moral ground. For you have only to ask yourself carefully, ‘Why do you not want to deceive?’ especially if it should seem — and it does seem! — as if life aimed at semblance, i.e. error, deception, simulation, blinding, self- blinding, and when life on the largest scale has actually always shown itself to be on the side of the most unscrupulous polytropoi.” Charitably interpreted, such a resolve might perhaps be a quixotism, a slight, enthusiastic folly; but it could also be something worse, namely a principle that is hostile to life and destructive. ‘Will to truth’ — that could be a hidden will to death. Thus the question ‘Why science?’ leads back to the moral problem: Why morality at ail, if life, nature, and history are ‘immoral’? No doubt, those who are truthful in that audacious and ultimate sense which faith in science presupposes thereby

affirm another world than that of life, nature, and history; and insofar as they affirm this 'other world', must they not by the same token deny its counterpart, this world, our world? . . . But you will have gathered what I am getting at, namely, that it is still a metaphysical faith upon which our faith in science rests — that even we knowers of today, we godless anti- metaphysicians, still take our fire, too, from the flame lit by the thousand-year old faith, the Christian faith which was also Plato's faith, that God is truth; that truth is divine ... But what if this were to become more and more difficult to believe, if nothing more were to turn out to be divine except error, blindness, the lie — if God himself were to turn out to be our longest lie? 2 'sly, knowing all the tricks, devious'. Nietzsche uses the plural of this word which in the singular is used in the *Odyssey* (e.g. Book 1, line 1) to describe Odysseus. 201 *The Gay Science* 345 Morality as a problem. — "The lack of personality always takes its revenge: a weakened, thin, extinguished personality, one that denies itself and its own existence, is no longer good for anything good — least of all for philosophy. 'Selflessness' has no value in heaven or on earth; all great problems demand great Jove, and only strong, round, secure minds who have a firm grip on themselves are capable of that. It makes the most telling difference whether a thinker has a personal relationship to his problems and finds in them his destiny, his distress, and his greatest happiness, or an 'impersonal' one, meaning he is only able to touch and grasp them with the antennae of cold, curious thought. In the latter case nothing will come of it, that much can be promised; for even if great problems should let themselves be grasped by them, they would not allow frogs and weaklings to hold on to them; such has been their taste from time immemorial — a taste, incidentally, that they share with all doughty females. Why, then, have I never yet encountered anyone, not even in books, who approached morality in this personal way and who knew morality as a problem, and this problem as his own personal distress, torment, voluptuousness, and passion? It is clear that up to now, morality has been no problem at all but rather that on which, after all mistrust, discord, and contradiction, one could agree — the hallowed place of peace where thinkers took a rest from themselves, took a deep breath, and felt revived. I see no one who has ventured a critique of moral valuations; I miss even the slightest attempts of scientific curiosity, of the coddled, experimental imagination of psychologists and historians that easily anticipates a problem and seizes it in flight without knowing what it has caught. I have hardly detected a few meagre preliminary efforts to explore the history of origins of these feelings and valuations (which is something quite different from a critique and again different from a history of ethical systems): in one single case I did everything to encourage a sympathy and talent for this kind of history — in vain, as it seems to me today.* These historians of morality (particularly, the Englishmen) do not amount to much: usually they themselves unsuspectingly stand under the

command of a particular morality and, 3 Probably a reference to Dr Paul Rée (1849-1901), author of *Der Ursprung der moralischen Empfindungen* (1877) and *Die Entstehung des Gewissens* (1885). Nietzsche refers again to Rée in the Preface to 'On the Genealogy of Morality' (Cambridge, 1994). 202 Book Five: We Fearless Ones without knowing it, serve as its shield-bearers and followers, for example, by sharing that popular superstition of Christian Europe which people keep repeating so naively to this day, that what is characteristic of morality is selflessness, self-denial, self-sacrifice, or sympathy (*Mitgefühl*) and compassion (*Mitleiden*). Their usual mistaken premise is that they affirm some consensus among peoples, at least among tame peoples, concerning certain moral principles, and then conclude that these principles must be unconditionally binding also for you and me — or, conversely, they see that among different peoples moral valuations are necessarily different and infer from this that no morality is binding ~ both of which are equally childish. The mistake of the more subtle among them is that they uncover and criticize the possibly foolish opinions of a people about their morality, or of humanity about all human morality — opinions about its origin, its religious sanction, the myth of the free will and such things — and then think they have criticized the morality itself. But the value of the injunction 'Thou Shalt' is still fundamentally different from and independent of such opinions about it and the weeds of error that may have overgrown it — just as surely as the value of a medication for someone sick is totally independent of whether he thinks about medicine scientifically or the way an old woman thinks about it. A morality could even have grown out of an error, and the realization of this fact would not as much as touch the problem of its value. Thus no one until now has examined the value of that most famous of all medicines called morality; and for that, one must begin by questioning it for once. Well then! Precisely that is our task. 346 Our question mark. — But you do not understand this? Indeed, people will have trouble understanding us. We are searching for words, perhaps also for ears. Who are we anyway? If we simply called ourselves godless (to use an old expression), or unbelievers, or even immoralists, we would not think that these words came near to describing us: we are all three of them, at too advanced a stage for anyone to comprehend — for you to comprehend, my curious gentlemen — how it feels. No! No longer with the bitterness and passion of the one who has torn himself away and must turn his unbelief into another faith, a goal, a martyrdom! We 203 The Gay Science have become hard-boiled, cold, and tough in the realization that the way of the world is not at all divine — even by human standards it is not rational, merciful, or just. We know it: the world we live in is ungodly, immoral, 'inhuman'; for far too long we have interpreted it falsely and mendaciously, though according to our wish and will for veneration, that is, according to a need. For man is a venerating animal! But he is also a mistrustful one; and that the world is mot

worth what we thought is about the most certain thing our mistrust has finally gotten hold of. The more mistrust, the more philosophy. We take care not to claim that the world is worth /ess; indeed, it would seem laughable to us today if man were to aim at inventing values that were supposed to surpass the value of the real world. That is exactly what we have turned away from, as from an extravagant aberration of human vanity and unreason that for long was not recognized as such. It found its final expression in modern pessimism, and an older and stronger expression in the teaching of Buddha; but also Christianity includes it, more doubtfully and ambiguously, to be sure, but not for that reason less seductively. The whole attitude of 'man against the world', of man as a 'world-negating' principle, of man as the measure of the value of things, as judge of the world who finally places existence itself on his scales and finds it too light — the monstrous stupidity of this attitude has finally dawned on us and we are sick of it; we laugh we soon as we encounter the juxtaposition of 'man and world', separated by the sublime presumptuousness of the little word 'and!' But by laughing, haven't we simply taken contempt for man one step further? And thus also pessimism, the contempt for that existence which is knowable to us? Have we not exposed ourselves to the suspicion of an opposition — an opposition between the world in which until now we were at home with our venerations — and which may have made it possible for us to endure life — and another world that we ourselves are: a relentless, fundamental, deepest suspicion concerning ourselves that is steadily gaining more and worse control over us Europeans and that could easily confront coming generations with the terrible Either/Or: 'Either abolish your venerations or — yourselves!' The latter would be nihilism; but would not the former also be — nihilism? That is our question mark. 204 Book Five: We Fearless Ones 347 Behevers and their need to believe. - The extent to which one needs a faith in order to flourish, how much that is 'firm' and that one does not want shaken because one clings to it — that is a measure of the degree of one's strength (or, to speak more clearly, one's weakness). Christianity, it seems to me, is still needed by most people in old Europe even today; hence it still finds believers. For that is how man is: an article of faith could be refuted to him a thousand times; as long as he needed it, he would consider it 'true' again and again, in accordance with that famous 'proof of strength'* of which the Bible speaks. Metaphysics is still needed by some, but so is that impetuous demand for certainty that today discharges itself in scientific-positivistic form among great masses — the demand that one wants by all means something to be firm (while owing to the fervour of this demand one treats the demonstration of this certainty more lightly and negligently): this is still the demand for foothold, support — in short, the instinct of weakness that, to be sure, does not create sundry religions, forms of metaphysics, and convictions but does — preserve them. Indeed, around all these positivistic

systems hover the fumes of a certain pessimistic gloom, something of a weariness, fatalism, disappointment, fear of new disappointment — or else self-dramatizing rage, a bad mood, the anarchism of exasperation and whatever other symptoms or masquerades there are of the feeling of weakness. Even the vehemence with which our cleverest contemporaries get lost in pitiful nooks and crevices such as patriotism (I refer to what the French call *chauvinisme*? and the Germans ‘German’), or in petty aesthetic creeds such as French naturalism (which enhances and exposes only the part of nature that simultaneously disgusts and amazes — today one likes to call it *à la vérité vraie*® —), or in Petersburg-style nihilism’ (meaning faith in unbelief to the point of martyrdom), always indicates primarily the need for faith, a foothold, backbone, support . . . Faith is + See 1 Corinthians 2:4. Originally this seems to have referred to the view that Christianity was true because it was possible effectively to cure illnesses and drive out demons by invoking the name of Jesus. By the eighteenth century (in Germany) the doctrine had been transformed into the view that Christianity was true because firm belief in Jesus gave the believer power in the form of an optimistic attitude towards life that would make it possible to cope effectively with adversity. ‘jingoistic xenophobia’ ‘true truth’ see Turgenev (1818-83) *Fathers and Sons* (1862); Dostoyevsky, *The Possessed*. ores 205 The Gay Science always most desired and most urgently needed where will is lacking; for will, as the affect of command, is the decisive mark of sovereignty and strength. That is, the less someone knows how to command, the more urgently does he desire someone who commands, who commands severely — a god, prince, the social order, doctor, father confessor, dogma, or party conscience. From this one might gather that both world religions, Buddhism and Christianity, may have owed their origin and especially their sudden spread to a tremendous sickening of the will. And that is actually what happened: both religions encountered a demand for a ‘Thou Shalt’ that, through a sickening of the will, had increased to an absurd level and bordered on desperation; both religions were teachers of fanaticism in times of a slackening of the will and thereby offered innumerable people support, a new possibility of willing, a delight in willing. For fanaticism is the only ‘strength of the will’ that even the weak and insecure can be brought to attain, as a type of hypnosis of the entire sensual-intellectual system to the benefit of the excessive nourishment (hypertrophy) of a single point of view and feeling which is now dominant — the Christian calls it his faith. Once a human being arrives at the basic conviction that he must be commanded, he becomes ‘a believer’; conversely, one could conceive of a delight and power of self-determination, a freedom of the will, in which the spirit takes leave of all faith and every wish for certainty, practised as it is in maintaining itself on light ropes and possibilities and dancing even beside abysses. Such a spirit would be the free spirit par excellence. 348 On the origin of scholars. — In Europe the

scholar grows out of all kinds of classes and social conditions like a plant that requires no particular kind of soil: thus he belongs, essentially and involuntarily, to the bearers of the democratic idea. But this origin betrays itself. Once one has some- what trained one's eye to recognize in a scholarly book, in a scientific treatise, the scholar's intellectual idiosyncrasy ~ every scholar has one — and catch it in the act, one will almost always behind it come face to face with the scholar's 'prehistory', his family, especially its occupations and crafts. Where the feeling, "This is now proven; I am done with it," is expressed, it is usually the ancestor in the blood and instincts of the scholar who from his standpoint approves of 'the finished job' — the 206 Book Five: We Fearless Ones faith in a proof is only the symptom of what in a hard-working family for ages has been considered 'good work'. An example: the sons of all types of clerks and office workers, whose main task was always to organize various different kinds of material, to compartmentalize and in general to schematize, when they become scholars, show a tendency to consider a problem practically solved when they have merely schema- tized it. There are philosophers who are basically just schematizers — for them, the formal aspect of their fathers' occupation has become content. The talent for classifications, for tables of categories, reveals something: one pays the price for being the child of one's parents. The son of a lawyer will also, as a researcher, have to be a lawyer; he primarily wants his cause to win; secondarily perhaps also for it to be right. The sons of Protestant ministers and schoolteachers one recognizes by the naive certainty with which, as scholars, they take their case already to have been proven when they have merely stated it heartily and warmly; they are thoroughly used to being believed, as that was part of their father's craft. A Jew, on the other hand, in keeping with the characteristic occupations and the past of his people, is not at all used to being believed. Consider Jewish scholars in this light: they all have a high regard for logic, that is for compelling agreement by force of reasons, they know that with logic, they are bound to win even when faced with class and race prejudices, where people do not willingly believe them. For nothing is more democratic than logic: it knows no regard for persons and takes even the crooked nose for straight. (Incidentally, Europe owes the Jews no small thanks for making its people more logical, for cleaner intellectual habits — none more so than the Germans, as a lamentably *dérisonnable*® race that even today first needs to be given a good mental drubbing. Wherever Jews have gained influence, they have taught people to make finer distinctions, draw more rigorous conclusions, and to write more clearly and cleanly; their task was always 'to make a people "listen to reason" '.) 349 Once again, the origin of the scholars. — To wish to preserve oneself is a sign of distress, of a limitation of the truly basic life-instinct, which aims 8 'ynreasonable' 207 The Gay Science at the expansion of power and in so doing often enough risks and sacrifices self-preservation. It is symptomatic that

certain philosophers, such as the consumptive Spinoza, took and indeed had to take just the so-called self-preservation instinct to be decisive: — they were simply people in distress. That today's natural sciences have become so entangled with the Spinozistic dogma (most recently and crudely in Darwinism with its incredibly one-sided doctrine of 'the struggle for existence' —) is probably due to the descent of most natural scientists: in this regard they belong to 'the people', their ancestors were poor and lowly folks who knew all too intimately the difficulty of scraping by. English Darwinism exudes something like the stuffy air of English overpopulation, like the small people's smell of indigence and overcrowding. As a natural scientist, however, one should get out of one's human corner; and in nature, it is not distress which rules, but rather abundance, squandering — even to the point of absurdity. The struggle for survival is only an exception, a temporary restriction of the will to life; the great and small struggle revolves everywhere around preponderance, around growth and expansion, around power and in accordance with the will to power, which is simply the will to life. 350 In honour of the homines religiosi!^o - The struggle against the church is certainly, among other things — for it means many things — also the struggle of the baser, meaner, more cheerful, more confiding, more superficial natures against the dominion of the graver, deeper, and more contemplative, that is, more evil and distrustful individuals who, with a long-standing suspicion about the value of existence, also brooded over their own worth: the base instinct of the people, its sensuality, its 'good heart', rebelled against them. The entire Roman Church rests on a Southern distrust of human nature which is always misunderstood in the North. The European South has inherited this suspicion from the deep Orient, from ancient mysterious Asia and its contemplation. Protestantism is, to be sure, an uprising in favour of the upright, the guileless, the shallow (the North has always been more good-natured and superficial than the South); but it was the French Revolution that ® Spinoza, *Ethica*, Book IV, props. 18-25 (esp. Scholium to prop. 18) 10 'religious people' 208 Book Five: We Fearless Ones finally and ceremoniously handed over the sceptre to the 'good people' (to the sheep, the donkey, the goose, and everything that is incurably shallow and loudmouthed and ripe for the madhouse of 'modern ideas'). 351 In honour of the priestly type: — | think that what the people mean by wisdom (and who today is not 'people'?) — that prudent, cowlike serenity, piety and country parson meekness which lies in the meadow and earnestly and ruminantly observes life — is also that from which precisely the philosophers have always felt the most remote, probably because they were not 'people' enough, not country parsons enough. They will presumably also be the last to learn to believe that the people might come to understand something of that which is most remote from them, something of the great passion of the knowledge-seeker who steadfastly lives, must live, in the thundercloud of the

highest problems and the weightiest responsibilities (and thus in no way as an observer, outside, indifferent, secure, objective. . .). The people venerate quite another type of person when they construct for themselves an ideal of the ‘sage’, and they have a thousandfold right to adore just this type of person with the best words and honours — the mild, serious/simple-minded and chaste priestly natures and whatever is related to them: they are the ones who are the objects of approbation when the common people reveres wisdom. And towards whom would the people have more reason to show themselves grateful than these men, who belong to and come from them, though as consecrated, chosen, sacrificed for the common good — they believe themselves sacrificed to God —, to whom the people can spill their hearts with impunity and get rid of their secrets, worries and worse (— for he who ‘unbosoms’ himself is relieved of himself, and he who has ‘confessed’, forgets). Here reigns a great necessity: drainages and their clean, cleansing waters are needed also for the spiritual refuse; swift streams of love are needed, and strong, humble, pure hearts who prepare and sacrifice themselves for such an office of non-public health care — for it is a sacrifice; a priest is and remains a human sacrifice. . .The people see such sacrificed, subdued, serious persons of ‘faith’ as wise, that is, as having become knowing, as ‘certain’ in relation to their own uncertainty; and who would want to deprive them of this word and of their awe? But as is conversely fair, 209 The Gay Science among philosophers a priest, too, is considered to be one of ‘the people’ and not a knower, primarily because philosophers do not themselves believe in ‘men of knowledge’ and already smell ‘the people’ in this belief and superstition. It was modesty that in Greece coined the word ‘philosopher’ and left the extraordinary insolence of calling oneself wise to the actors of the spirit — the modesty of such monsters of pride and conceit as Pythagoras, as Plato — . 352 The extent to which morality is hardly dispensable. - The naked human being is generally a disgraceful sight — I am talking about us Europeans (and not even about female Europeans!). Supposing that by the mischievous trick of a sorcerer, the merriest dinner party suddenly saw itself exposed and undressed; I think not only the mirth would be lost but also the strongest appetite discouraged, — it seems we Europeans are utterly unable to dispense with that masquerade called clothing. But why should there not be equally good reasons for the disguise of ‘moral men’, for their veil of moral formulas and notions of decency, for the whole benevolent concealment of our actions behind the concepts of duty, virtue, public spirit, respectability, self-denial? I am not supposing that something like human malice and perfidy — in short, the bad wild beast in us — is thereby disguised; my thought is, quite on the contrary, that it is precisely as tame animals that are we a disgraceful sight and need the disguise of morality, — that the ‘inner man’ in Europe is not nearly evil enough to be able to ‘show himself’ that way (and be beautiful that way —). The European disguises himself with morality because he

has become a sick, sickly, maimed animal which has good reasons for being 'tame'; because he is almost a monstrosity, something half, weak, awkward. . . It is not the ferocity of the beast of prey that needs a moral disguise, but the herd animal with its deep mediocrity, fear, and boredom with itself. Morality dresses up the European — \et's admit it! — into something nobler, grander, goodlier, something 'divine' — 353 On the origin of religions. ~ The true invention of the religion-founders is first to establish a certain way of life and everyday customs that work as 210 Book Five: We Fearless Ones a *disciplina voluntatis*" while at the same time removing boredom; and then to give just this life an interpretation that makes it appear illuminated by the highest worth, so that henceforth it becomes a good for which one fights and under certain circumstances even gives one's life. Actually, the second invention is the more important: the first, the way of life, was usually already in place, though alongside other ways of life and without any consciousness of its special worth. The significance, the originality of the religion-founder usually lies in his seemg and selecting this way of life, in his guessing for the first time what it can be used for and how it can be interpreted. Jesus (or Paul), for example, discovered the life of the small people in the Roman province, a humble, virtuous, depressed life: he explained it, he put the highest meaning and value into it — and thereby also the courage to despise every other way of life, the silent Moravian brotherhood!" fanaticism, the clandestine subterranean self-confidence that grows and grows and is finally ready to 'overcome the world' (i.e. Rome and the upper classes throughout the empire). Buddha likewise discovered, scattered indeed among all classes and social strata of his people, that type of person who is good and gracious (above all, inoffensive) out of laziness and who, also from laziness, lives abstinently and with nearly no needs at all: he understood how such a type of person would inevitably, with all of his *vis inertiae*,TM have to roll into a faith that promises to prevent the return of earthly toil (i.e. of work and action in general), — this 'understanding' was his genius. The religion-founder must be psychologically infallible in his knowledge of a certain average breed of souls who have not yet recognized one another as allies. He is the one who brings them together; and to that extent, the establishment of a religion always turns into a long festival of recognition. — 354 On 'the genius of the species'. - The problem of consciousness (or rather, of becoming conscious of something) first confronts us when we begin to realize how much we can do without it; and now we are brought to 11 "discipline of the will" 12 A Christian religious group founded in 1722 in the town of Herrnhut (Germany). Members of the group de-emphasized technical points of religious doctrine and theology in favour of individual emotional experience and fraternal forms of living. 13 "force of inertia" 211 The Gay Science this initial realization by physiology and natural history (which have thus required two hundred years to catch up with Letbniz's precocious

suspicion).'+ For we could think, feel, will, remember, and also 'act' in every sense of the term, and yet none of all this would have to 'enter our consciousness' (as one says figuratively). All of life would be possible without, as it were, seeing itself in the mirror; and still today, the predominant part of our lives actually unfolds without this mirroring — of course also our thinking, feeling, and willing lives, insulting as it may sound to an older philosopher. To what end does consciousness exist at all when it is basically superfluous? If one is willing to hear my answer and its possibly extravagant conjecture, it seems to me that the subtlety and strength of consciousness is always related to a person's (or animal's) ability to communicate; and the ability to communicate, in turn, to the need to communicate. The latter should not be taken to mean that precisely that individual who is a master at expressing his needs and at making them understood must also be the most dependent on others in his needs. But for entire races and lineages, this seems to me to hold: where need and distress have for a long time forced people to communicate, to understand each other swiftly and subtly, there finally exists a surplus of this power and art of expression, a faculty, so to speak, which has slowly accumulated and now waits for an heir to spend it lavishly (the so-called artists are the heirs, as well as the orators, preachers, writers — all of them people who come at the end of a long chain, each of them 'born late' in the best sense of the term, and each of them, again, squanderers by nature). Assuming this observation is correct, I may go on to conjecture that consciousness in general has developed only under the pressure of the need to communicate; that at the outset, consciousness was necessary, was useful, only between persons (particularly between those who commanded and those who obeyed); and that it has developed only in proportion to that usefulness. Consciousness is really just a net connecting one person with another — only in this capacity did it have to develop; the solitary and predatory person would not have needed it. That our actions, thoughts, feelings, and movements — at least some of them ~ even enter into consciousness is the result of a terrible 'must' which has ruled over man for a long time: as the most endangered animal, he needed help and protection, he 1+ German philosopher (1646—1716) who held that we had perceptions of which we were not aware; see his *Monadology*, § 14. 212 Book Five: We Fearless Ones needed his equals; he had to express his neediness and be able to make himself understood — and to do so, he first needed 'consciousness', i.e. even to 'know' what distressed him, to 'know' how he felt, to 'know' what he thought. For, once again: man, like every living creature, is constantly thinking but does not know it; the thinking which becomes conscious is only the smallest part of it, let's say the shallowest, worst part — for only that conscious thinking takes place in words, that is, in communication symbols; and this fact discloses the origin of conscious- ness. In short, the development of language and the development of consciousness (not of reason

but strictly of the way in which we become conscious of reason) go hand in hand. One might add that not only language serves as a bridge between persons, but also look, touch, and gesture; without our becoming conscious of our sense impressions, our power to fix them and as it were place them outside of ourselves, has increased in proportion to the need to convey them to others by means of signs. The sign-inventing person is also the one who becomes ever more acutely conscious of himself; for only as a social animal did man learn to become conscious of himself — he is still doing it, and he is doing it more and more. My idea is clearly that consciousness actually belongs not to man's existence as an individual but rather to the community- and herd-aspects of his nature; that accordingly, it is finely developed only in relation to its usefulness to community or herd; and that consequently each of us, even with the best will in the world to understand ourselves as individually as possible, 'to know ourselves', will always bring to consciousness precisely that in ourselves which is 'non- individual', that which is 'average'; that due to the nature of consciousness — to the 'genius of the species' governing it — our thoughts themselves are continually as it were outvoted and translated back into the herd perspective. At bottom, all our actions are incomparably and utterly personal, unique, and boundlessly individual, there is no doubt; but as soon as we translate them into consciousness, they no longer seem to be...This is what I consider to be true phenomenalism and perspectivism: that due to the nature of animal consciousness, the world of which we can become conscious is merely a surface- and sign-world, a world turned into generalities and thereby debased to its lowest common denominator, — that everything which enters consciousness thereby becomes shallow, thin, relatively stupid, general, a sign, a herd-mark; that all becoming conscious involves a vast and thorough 213 *The Gay Science* corruption, falsification, superficialization, and generalization. In the end, the growing consciousness is a danger; and he who lives among the most conscious Europeans even knows it is a sickness. As one might guess, it is not the opposition between subject and object which concerns me here; I leave that distinction to those epistemologists who have got tangled up in the snares of grammar (of folk metaphysics). Even less am I concerned with the opposition between 'thing in itself' and appearance: for we 'know' far too little to even be entitled to make that distinction. We simply have no organ for knowing, for 'truth': we 'know' (or believe or imagine) exactly as much as is useful to the human herd, to the species: and even what is here called 'usefulness' is finally also just a belief, a fiction, and perhaps just that supremely fatal stupidity of which we some day will perish. 355 The origin of our concept of 'knowledge'. — I take this explanation from the street; I heard one of the common people say 'he knew me right away' — and I asked myself: what do the people actually take knowledge to be? what do they want when they want 'knowledge'? Nothing

more than this: something unfamiliar is to be traced back to something familiar. And we philosophers — have we really meant anything more by knowledge? The familiar means what we are used to, so that we no longer marvel at it; the commonplace; some rule in which we are stuck; each and every thing that makes us feel at home: — And isn't our need for knowledge precisely this need for the familiar, the will to uncover among everything strange, unusual, and doubtful something which no longer unsettles us? Is it not the instinct of fear that bids us to know? And isn't the rejoicing of the person who attains knowledge just rejoicing from a regained sense of security? . . . Take the philosopher who imagined the world to be 'known' when he had reduced it to the 'idea'; wasn't it precisely because the 'idea' was so familiar to him and he was so used to it? because he no longer feared the 'idea'? — How little these men of knowledge demand! Just look at their principles and their solutions to the world riddle with this in mind! When they find something in, under, or behind things which unfortunately happens to be very familiar to us, such as our multiplication table or our logic or our willing and desiring, how happy they are right away! For 'what is 214 Book Five: We Fearless Ones familiar is known': on this they agree. Even the most cautious among them assume that the familiar can at least be more easily known than the strange; that for example sound method demands that we start from the 'inner world', from the 'facts of consciousness', because this world is more familiar to us. Error of errors! The familiar is what we are used to, and what we are used to is the most difficult to 'know' — that is, to view as a problem, to see as strange, as distant, as 'outside us'. . . The great certainty of the natural sciences in comparison with psychology and the critique of the elements of consciousness ~ with the unnatural sciences, one might almost say — rests precisely on the fact that they take the strange as their object, while it is nearly contradictory and absurd even to want to take the not-strange as one's object. . .

356 The extent to which things will become ever more 'artistic' in Europe. — Even today, in this transitional period in which so many forms of coercion have lost their power, the need to make a living still forces nearly all European men to adopt a particular role — their so-called profession. A few retain the freedom, an apparent freedom, to choose this role themselves; for most of them it is chosen. The result is strange enough. Almost all Europeans, at an advanced age, confuse themselves with their role; they become the victims of their 'good performance'; they themselves have forgotten how much they were determined by accidents, moods, and arbitrariness at the time that their 'profession' was decided — and how many other roles they may have been able to play; for now it is too late! Upon deeper consideration, the role has actually become character; and artifice, nature. There were times when men believed with unyielding confidence, even with piety, in their predestination for just this business, just this way of making a living, and utterly refused to acknowledge the element of accident, role, and

caprice. With the help of this faith, estates, guilds, and inherited trade privileges were able to establish those monsters, the broad-based social pyramids that distinguished the middle ages and to which one can credit at least one thing: durability (and durability is a first-rank value on earth). But there are contrary ages, the truly democratic ones, in which people unlearn this faith and a certain audacious faith and opposite viewpoint moves steadily into the foreground - the Athenian faith that first became noticeable in the 215 The Gay Science Periclean age;!> the American faith which is increasingly becoming the European faith as well, where the individual is convinced he can do just about anything and is up to playing any role; and everyone experiments with himself, improvises, experiments again, enjoys experimenting, where all nature ends and becomes art. . .When the Greeks had fully accepted this faith in roles — the faith of artistes, if you will — they underwent, as is well known, step by step an odd metamorphosis that is not in every respect worthy of imitation: they really became actors; as such they captivated and overcame the whole world — finally even the ‘power that overcame the whole world’ itself (for it was not, as innocents tend to say, Greek culture that conquered Rome, but the *graeculus histrio*®). But what I fear, what even today one could grasp with one’s hands if one felt like grasping it, is that we modern men are pretty much on the same road; and every time man starts to discover the extent to which he is playing a role and the extent to which he can be an actor, he becomes an actor. . .With this, a new human flora and fauna emerges that cannot grow in firmer and more limited ages — or that would at least be formally condemned and suspected of lacking honour; it is thus that the most interesting and maddest ages always emerge, in which ‘the actors’, all types of actors, are the real masters. Precisely because of this, another human type becomes ever more disadvantaged and is finally made impossible; above all, the great ‘architects’: the strength to build is now paralysed; the courage to make far-reaching plans is discouraged; the organizational geniuses become scarce — who still dares to undertake works that would require millennia to complete? For what is dying out is that fundamental faith on the basis of which someone could calculate, promise, anticipate the future in a plan on that grand scale, and sacrifice the future to his plan — namely, the basic faith that man has worth and sense only in so far as he is @ stone in a great edifice; to this end he must be firm above all, a ‘stone’ . . above all not an actor! To put it briefly — oh, people will keep silent about it for a long time! — what from now on will never again be built, can never again be built, is — a society in the old sense of the term; to build that, everything is lacking, mainly the material. We are all no longer material for a society; this is a timely truth! 15 The mid-fifth century BC, named after Pericles, the Athenian statesman who was in power during that period and who was thought by some to embody some of its salient virtues. 16 little Greek actor’. ‘Graeculus’ (‘little Greek’) was used by

Romans as a term of contempt; see Juvenal 3.78. 216 Book Five: We Fearless Ones It is a matter of indifference to me that at present the most short-sighted, perhaps the most honest, at any rate the noisiest human type that we have today — our good socialists — believe, hope, dream, and above all shout and write pretty much the opposite. For even now one reads their slogan for the future ‘free society’ on all tables and walls. Free society? Well, well! But surely you know, gentlemen, what one needs to build that? Wooden iron!!? The famous wooden iron! And it need not even be wooden. . . 357 On the old problem: ‘What is German?’ — Add up for yourself the real achievements in philosophical thinking that can be attributed to Germans: is there any legitimate sense in which one can credit them to the entire race? Can we say that they are also the work of the ‘German soul’, or at least symptoms of it in the same sense in which we are accustomed to take Plato’s ideomania, his nearly religious lunacy about forms, as a development and testimony of ‘the Greek soul’? Or would the opposite be true? Would they be just so individual, just so much exceptions to the spirit of the race as was, for instance, Goethe’s paganism with a good conscience? Or as is Bismarck’s Machiavellianism with a good conscience, his so-called Realpolitik, among Germans? Might our philosophers perhaps even contradict the need of the ‘German soul’? In short, were the German philosophers really — philosophical Germans? I recall three cases. First, Leibniz’s incomparable insight!® that has been vindicated not only against Descartes but also against everyone who had philosophized before him — that consciousness (Bewußttheit)? is merely an *accidens*”° of the power of representation (Vorstellung) and not its necessary and essential attribute; so that what we call consciousness (Bewußtsein) constitutes only one state of our spiritual and psychic world (perhaps a sick state) and by no means the whole of it ~ is there something German to this idea, the profundity of which has not been exhausted to this day? Is there reason to surmise that no Latin could easily have thought of this reversal of appearances? 17 Common expression in German for something that cannot exist, like ‘square circle’. 18 See above, Book v, footnote 14, p. 212. 19 See above, Book 1, footnote 6, p. 37. 20 ‘accident’ in the sense of ‘inessential property’ 217 The Gay Science For it is a reversal. Let us recall, secondly, Kant’s colossal question mark that he placed on the concept ‘causality’! — without, like Hume, doubting its legitimacy altogether: he started much more cautiously to delimit the realm in which this concept makes any sense whatsoever (and to this day we have not yet come to terms with this marking out of the boundaries). Let us take, thirdly, Hegel’s astonishing move, with which he struck through all logical habits and indulgences when he dared to teach that species concepts develop out of each other:”? with this proposition the minds of Europe were preformed for the last great scientific movement, Darwinism — for without Hegel there could be no Darwin. Is there anything German in this Hegelian innovation which first

introduced the decisive concept of ‘development’ into science? Yes, without any doubt: in all three cases we feel that something in ourselves has been ‘uncovered’ and figured out, and we are grateful and at the same time surprised. Each of these three propositions is a thoughtful piece of German self-knowledge, self-experience, and self-conception. ‘Our inner world is much richer, more comprehensive, more hidden’, we feel with Leibniz. As Germans, we doubt with Kant the ultimate validity of the discoveries of the natural sciences and altogether of everything that can be known causaliter?? — what is knowable already seems to us of less value on that account. We Germans are Hegelians even had there been no Hegel, insofar as we (as opposed to all Latins) instinctively attribute a deeper meaning and greater value to becoming and development than to what ‘is’; we hardly believe in the justification of the concept ‘being’ — and also insofar as we are not inclined to concede that our human logic is logic as such or the only kind of logic (we would rather persuade ourselves that it is only a special case and perhaps one of the oddest and stupidest). A fourth question would be whether Schopenhauer, too, with his pessimism — that is, the problem of the value of existence? — had to be precisely a German. I believe not. The event after which this problem was to be expected with certainty, so that an astronomer of the soul could have calculated the very day and hour for it — the decline of the faith in the Christian god, the triumph of scientific atheism — is a pan-European event in which all races had their share. See Kant’s Preface to *Prolegomena to any Future Metaphysics* (1783). 22 See Hegel’s *Encyclopedia of Philosophical Sciences* (1830 edn), § 368 (especially the Zusatz). ‘causally’ 24 See Schopenhauer, *World as Will and Representation* vol. 1, Book 4, and vol. 11, chapters 46 and 49. 218 Book Five: We Fearless Ones share and for which all deserve credit and honour. Conversely, one might charge precisely the Germans — those Germans who were contemporaries of Schopenhauer — with having delayed this triumph of atheism most dangerously for the longest time. Hegel in particular was a delayer par excellence, in accordance with his grandiose attempt to persuade us of the divinity of existence, appealing as a last resort to our sixth sense, ‘the historical sense’. As a philosopher, Schopenhauer was the first admitted and uncompromising atheist among us Germans: this was the background of his enmity towards Hegel. The ungodliness of existence counted for him as something given, palpable, indisputable; he always lost his philosopher’s composure and became indignant when he saw anyone hesitate or beat around the bush on this point. This is the locus of his whole integrity; unconditional and honest atheism is simply the presupposition of his way of putting the problem, as a victory of the European conscience won finally and with great difficulty; as the most fateful act of two thousand years of discipline for truth that in the end forbids itself the /ie of faith in God. . . One can see what it was that actually

triumphed over the Christian god: Christian morality itself, the concept of truthfulness that was taken ever more rigorously; the father confessor's refinement of the Christian conscience, translated and sublimated into a scientific conscience, into intellectual cleanliness at any price. Looking at nature as if it were proof of the goodness and care of a god; interpreting history in honour of some divine reason, as a continual testimony of a moral world order and ultimate moral purposes; interpreting one's own experiences as pious people have long interpreted theirs, as if everything were providential, a hint, designed and ordained for the sake of salvation of the soul — that is over now; that has conscience against it; every refined conscience considers it to be indecent, dishonest, a form of mendacity, effeminacy, weakness, cowardice. With this severity, if with anything, we are simply good Europeans and heirs of Europe's longest and most courageous self-overcoming. As we thus reject Christian interpretation and condemn its 'meaning' as counterfeit, Schopenhauer's question immediately comes at us in a terrifying way: Does existence have any meaning at all? A few centuries will be needed before this question can ever be heard completely and in its full depth. What Schopenhauer himself said in answer to this question was — forgive me — something hasty, youthful, a mere compromise, a way of remaining and staying stuck in precisely 219 *The Gay Science* those Christian and ascetic moral perspectives in which one had renounced faith along with the faith in God. But he posed the question — as a good European, as I said before, and not as a German. Or is it possible that at least the manner in which the Germans appropriated Schopenhauer's question proves that the Germans did have an inner affinity and relation, preparation, and need for this problem? 'That after Schopenhauer one thought and printed things in Germany, too — by the way, late enough — about the problem he had posed is certainly not sufficient to decide in favour of this closer affinity. One might rather adduce the peculiar ineptitude of this post-Schopenhauerian pessimism against the thesis; clearly the Germans did not behave in this affair as if they were in their element. This is by no means an allusion to Eduard von Hartmann.'"> On the contrary, to this day I have not shaken off my old suspicion that he is too apt for us. I mean that he may have been a real rogue from the start who perhaps made fun not only of German pessimism — but in the end he might even reveal to the Germans in his last will and testament to what extent it was possible to make fools of them, even in an era of economic initiative and success."° But let me ask you: should we perhaps consider that old humming-top Bahnsen?" as a credit to the Germans, seeing how voluptuously he revolved his life around his real-dialectical misery and 'personal bad luck'? Might precisely that be German? (I herewith recommend his writings to the end for which I have used them myself, as an anti-pessimistic diet, especially on account of their *elegantiae psychologicae*,"® with which, I think, they should be effective also

for the most constipated bowels and temperaments.) Or could one count such dilettantes and old spinsters as that mawkish apostle of virginity, Mainlander,”? as a genuine German? In the end he must have been a Jew (all Jews become mawkish when they moralize). Neither Bahnsen nor Mainlander, nor even Eduard von Hartmann, gives us any clear evidence regarding the question whether Schopenhauer’s pessimism, his horrified look into a de-deified world 25 Nineteenth-century German philosopher who drew eclectically on both Hegel and Schopenhauer to develop a pessimistic ‘philosophy of the unconscious’ The 1870s were a period of such economic prosperity that they are sometimes referred to as the ‘Era of Foundations’ (of various business enterprises). Deservedly forgotten nineteenth-century German philosopher ‘psychological elegance’ In his *Philosophie der Erlösung* (2 vols., 1876—7): Phillip Batz ~ ‘Mainlander’ is a pseudonym — makes much of the virtues of virginity (and of suicide). He committed suicide when the second volume of this work appeared, at the age of thirty-five. 26 2 2 2: oe oe 220 Book Five: We Fearless Ones that had become stupid, blind, crazed, and questionable, his honest horror. . . was not merely an exception among Germans but a German event. Everything else that is otherwise in the foreground — our brave politics, our merry fatherlandishness which resolutely enough consider all matters with a view to a not very philosophical principle (“Deutsch- land, Deutschland iiber alles°), *ie. sub specie speciei*,! namely the German species, bears emphatic witness to the opposite. No, the Germans of today are no pessimists. And Schopenhauer was a pessimist, to repeat, as a good European and not as a German. — 358 The peasant rebellion of the spirit. - We Europeans confront a world of tremendous ruins. A few things are still towering; much looks decayed and uncanny, while most things are already lying on the ground: picturesque enough — where has one ever seen more beautiful ruins? — and overgrown by large and small weeds. The Church is this city of decline: we see the religious society of Christianity shaken to its lowest foundations; faith in God has collapsed; faith in the Christian-ascetic ideal is still fighting its last battle. An edifice such as Christianity that had been built so carefully over such a long period — it was the last Roman construction! — could of course not be destroyed all at once. All kinds of earthquakes had to shake it; all kinds of minds (Gezst) that drill, dig, gnaw, and moisten have had to help. But the oddest thing is: those who exerted themselves the most to preserve and conserve Christianity have become its best destroyers — the Germans. It seems that the Germans do not understand the nature of a church. Are they not spiritual enough for that? Not mistrustful enough? The edifice of the Church rests, at any rate, on a Southern freedom and liberality of the 30 First line of a poem written in 1841 by Hoffmann von Fallersleben. At the time of its composition ‘Germany’? was no more than a geographical expression for a congeries of independent political entities. In this context the words were a call to put national

unification ~ the creation of a ‘Germany’ — above all regional and local political loyalties. Once unification was attained (in 1871), the words could come to bear a more aggressive meaning in an international context (‘Let Germany be above all other nations’). In 1797 Haydn had composed a melody, deriving it from an existing Croatian folktune, which he used to set the words ‘Gott erhalte Franz den Kaiser’ (‘God Save Kaiser Franz’). Until 1918 this was the anthem of the Austro- Hungarian Empire. In 1922 Fallersleben’s poem was put together with Haydn’s melody and the result proclaimed the German National Anthem. 31

‘from the point of view of the species’ 221 The Gay Science mind as well as on a Southern suspicion against nature, man, and spirit; it rests on an altogether different knowledge and experience of man than the North has had. The Lutheran Reformation was, in its whole breadth, the indignation of simplicity against ‘multiplicity’, to speak cautiously, a crude, naively narrow-minded misunderstanding in which there is much to forgive. One failed to understand the expression of a victorious church and saw only corruption; one misunderstood the noble scepticism, that /uxury of scepticism and tolerance which every victorious, self-confident power permits itself. . . Today one overlooks easily enough how in all cardinal questions of power Luther was dangerously short-sighted, superficial, incautious — mainly as a man of the common people who lacked any inheritance from a ruling caste and instinct for power; thus his work, his will to restore that work of the Romans only became the beginning of a work of destruction, without his wanting and knowing it. With honest wrath he unravelled, he tore up what the old spider had woven so carefully for such a long time. He surrendered the holy books to everyone — thus they finally ended up in the hands of the philologists, who are the destroyers of every faith that rests on books. He destroyed the concept of the ‘Church’ by throwing away the belief in the inspiration of the church councils; for the concept of the ‘Church’ retains power only under the condition that the inspiring spirit that founded the Church still lives in, builds, and continues to build its house. He gave back to the priest sexual intercourse with a woman; but three-quarters of the reverence of which the people, especially the women of the people, are capable rests on the faith that a person who is an exception in this regard will be an exception in other regards as well — it is here precisely that the popular faith in something superhuman in man, in the miracle, in the redeeming god in man, finds its subtlest and most insidious advocate. Having given the priest woman, Luther had to take from him auricular confession; that was psychologically right, but with that development the Christian priest was basically abolished, since his deepest utility has always been that he was a holy ear, a silent well, a grave for secrets. ‘Everyone his own priest’ ~ behind such formulas and their peasant cunning was hidden in Luther the abysmal hatred of ‘the higher human beings’ and the dominion of ‘the higher human beings’ as conceived by the Church; he smashed an ideal that he could not

attain, while he seemed to fight and abhor the degeneration of this ideal. Actually he, the impossible monk, 222 Book Five: We Fearless Ones pushed away the dominion of the homines religiosi, and thus he himself brought about within the ecclestaistical social order what in relation to the civil social order he attacked so intolerantly — a ‘peasants’ rebellion’. What grew out of his Reformation afterwards, good as well as bad, might be roughly calculated today; but who would be naive enough to praise or blame Luther on account of these consequences? He is innocent of everything; he did not know what he was doing. The flattening of the European mind, particularly in the North — its becoming more good-natured, if one prefers a moral term — advanced a large step with the Lutheran Reformation, there is no doubt; and owing to it also the flexibility and restlessness of the mind, its thirst for independence, its faith in a right to liberty, its ‘naturalness’. If in connection with this last point one wanted to give it the credit for having prepared and favoured what we today honour as ‘modern science’, one must surely add that it also shares the blame for the degeneration of the modern scholar, for his lack of reverence, shame, and depth, for the whole naive guilelessness and conventionality in matters of knowledge — in short for that plebeianism of the spirit that is peculiar to the last two centuries and from which even pessimism has not yet liberated us. ‘Modern ideas’ also belong to this peasant rebellion of the North against the colder, more ambiguous, mistrustful spirit of the South that built its greatest monument in the Christian Church. Let us not forget in the end what a church is, specifically as opposed to any ‘state’. A church is above all a structure for ruling that secures the highest rank to the more spiritual human beings and that believes in the power of spirituality to the extent of forbidding itself the use of all cruder instruments of force; and on that score alone the Church is under all circumstances a nobler institution than the state. 359 The revenge against the spirit and other ulterior motives of morality. — Morality — where do you suppose that it finds its most dangerous and insidious advocates? . . . There is a human being who has turned out badly, who does not have spirit enough to be able to enjoy it and just enough education to know this; bored, weary, a self-despiser; wealthy 32 ‘religious people’ 223 The Gay Science through inheritance, he is deprived even of the last comfort, ‘the blessings of work’, self-forgetfulness in ‘daily labour’. Such a person who is basically ashamed of his existence — perhaps he also harbours a few small vices — and on the other hand cannot keep himself from becoming more spoiled and touchy as a result of reading books he has no right to or through more spiritual company than he can digest: such a thoroughly poisoned human being — for spirit becomes poison, education becomes poison; ownership becomes poison, loneliness becomes poison in persons who have turned out badly in this way — eventually ends up in a state of habitual revenge, the will to revenge. . . - What do you think he finds necessary, absolutely necessary, to give

himself in his own eyes the appearance of superiority over more spiritual people and to obtain the pleasure of an accomplished revenge at least in his own imagination? Always morality; you can bet on that. Always big moral words. Always the boom-boom of justice, wisdom, holiness, virtue. Always the Stoicism of gesture (how well Stoicism conceals what one facks!). Always the cloak of prudent silence, of affability, of mildness, and whatever the other idealistic cloaks may be called under which incurable self-despisers, as well as the incurably vain, go about. Do not misunderstand me: among such born enemies of the spirit emerges occasionally the rare piece of humanity that the people revere under such names as saint and sage. From among such men come those monsters of morality who make noise, who make history — St Augustine*? is among them. Fear of spirit, revenge against spirit — oh how often have these propelling vices become the roots of virtues! Indeed, become virtues! And, as a question asked in confidence: even that philosopher's claim to wisdom which has been made here and there on earth; the maddest and most immodest of all claims — was it not always, in India as well as in Greece, primarily a hiding place? At times perhaps a hiding place chosen with pedagogical intent, which hallows so many lies; one has a tender regard for those who are still becoming, growing — for disciples who must often be defended against themselves through faith in a person (through an error). . . In most cases, however, it is a hiding place in which the philosopher saves himself owing to weariness, age, growing cold, hardening — as a wisdom of that instinct which the animals have before death — they go off alone, become silent, choose 33 North African rhetorician, theologian and bishop (AD 354~430) 224 Book Five: We Fearless Ones solitude, crawl into caves, become wise. . . What? Wisdom as a hiding place in which the philosopher hides himself from — spirit? 360 Two kinds of causes that are often confused. - This seems to me to be one of my most essential steps forward: I learned to distinguish the cause of acting from the cause of acting in a certain way, in a certain direction, with a certain goal. The first kind of cause is a quantum of dammed-up energy waiting to be used somehow, for something; the second kind, by contrast, is something quite insignificant, mostly a small accident in accordance with which this quantum 'discharges' itself in one particular way: the match versus the powder keg. Among these small accidents and matches I consider all so-called 'purposes' as well as the even more so-called 'vocations': they are relatively random, arbitrary, nearly in- different in relation to the enormous force of energy that presses on, as I said, to be used up somehow. The usual view is different: one is used to seeing the driving force precisely in the goals (purposes, professions, etc.), in keeping with a very ancient error; but it is only the directing force — one has mistaken the helmsman for the stream. And not even always the helmsman, the driving force. . . Is the 'goal', the 'purpose', not often enough a beautifying pretext, a self-deception of vanity after the fact

that does not want to acknowledge that the ship is following the current into which it has entered accidentally? That it 'wills' to go that way because it — must? That it certainly has a direction but — no helmsman whatsoever? We still need a critique of the concept of 'purpose'. 361 On the problem of the actor. - The problem of the actor has troubled me for a very long time; I was unsure (and still sometimes am) whether it is only from this angle that one can approach the dangerous concept of the 'artist' — a concept that has heretofore been treated with unpardonable generosity. Falseness with a good conscience; the delight in pretence erupting as a power that pushes aside, floods, and at times extinguishes one's so-called 'character'; the inner longing for a role and mask, for an appearance (Schein); an excess of capacities for all kinds of adaptation 225 The Gay Science that can no longer be satisfied in the service of the nearest, most narrowly construed utility — perhaps all of this is distinctive not only of the actor? Such an instinct will have developed most easily in lower- class families who had to survive under fluctuating pressures and coercions, in deep dependency; who had nimbly to cut their coats according to their cloth, always readapting to new circumstances, always having to act and pose differently until they slowly learned to turn their coats with every wind and thus almost turned into coats themselves — and masters of an art which they have fully assimilated so that it is an integral part of themselves, that art of perpetually playing at self-concealment which in animals we call mimicry — until finally this capacity, accumulated from generation to generation, becomes domineering, unreasonable, intractable, an instinct that learns to command other instincts and produces the actor, the 'artist' (the buffoon, the teller of lies, the fool, the jester, the clown primarily, but also the classical servant, Gil Blas; for it is in such types that we find the pre- history of the artist and often enough even of 'genius'). In more elevated social conditions, too, a similar human type develops under similar pressures; only here, the histrionic instinct is usually just barely kept in check by another instinct, as in the case of 'diplomats'. Incidentally, I would think that a good diplomat would be free at any time to become a good actor — provided, of course, that he were 'free' to do this. But as for the Jews, that people possessing the art of adaptability par excellence, one might, according to this train of thought, immediately see in them a world-historical organization for the cultivation of actors, a veritable breeding ground for actors; and indeed it is really high time to ask: what good actor today is not — a Jew? Also the Jew as a born literary man, as the true master of the European press, exercises this power by virtue of his histrionic ability, for the literary man is essentially an actor: he plays the 'expert', the 'specialist'. Finally, women: consider the whole history of women — mustn't they be actresses first and foremost? Listen to doctors who have hypnotized womenfolk; finally, love them — let yourself be 'hypnotized' by them! What is always the result? That they try to be 'taken for something'

even when they are being taken. . . Woman is so artistic. . . 34 See above, Book 11, footnote 9, p. 78. 226 Book Five: We Fearless Ones 362 Our faith in the masculinization of Europe. — We owe it to Napoleon (and not at all to the French Revolution, which aimed at the ‘brotherhood’ of peoples and a general, blooming exchange of hearts) that a few warlike centuries, incomparable to any other in history, are likely to follow in succession — in short, that we have entered the classic age of war, of sophisticated yet popular war on the largest scale (in terms of weapons, talents, discipline); all coming ages will look back on this kind of war with envy and deep respect as something perfect, for the national movement out of which this war glory is growing is merely the counter- shock against Napoleon and would not exist without Napoleon. He should be credited one day for having enabled man in Europe to become the master over the businessman and the philistine — perhaps even over ‘woman’, who has been spoiled by Christianity and the enthusiastic spirit of the eighteenth century, and even more by ‘modern ideas’. Napoleon, who saw something of a personal enemy in modern ideas and in civilization itself,>> proved through this enmity to be one of the greatest continuators of the Renaissance: he brought back a whole piece, a block of granite, perhaps the decisive one, of antiquity’s essence. And who knows whether this piece of antiquity’s essence will finally again become master of the national movement, and whether it must not make itself the heir and protractor in an affirmative sense of Napoleon ~— who wanted one Europe, as is known, and wanted it as mistress of the earth. ~ 363 How each sex has its own prejudice about love. ~ Despite all the concessions I am willing to make to the prejudice favouring monogamy, I will never admit talk of egua/ rights for man and woman in love: there are none. For man and woman have different conceptions of love — and it belongs to the conditions of love in each sex that neither presupposes the same feeling, the same concept of ‘love’ in the other. What woman means by love is clear enough: total devotion (and not mere surrender) with soul and body, without any consideration or reserve, rather with shame and horror at the thought of a devotion that might be tied to 35 See above, Book 1, footnote 16, p. 49. In this case see vol. 1, p. 112. 227 The Gay Science special clauses or conditions. In this absence of conditions her love is a faith: woman has no other. Man, when he loves a woman, wants precisely this love from her and is thus himself as far as can be from the presupposition of female love; supposing, however, that there should also be men to whom the desire for complete surrender is not alien, well, then they are — not men. A man who loves like a woman becomes a slave, but a woman who loves like a woman becomes a more perfect woman... The passion of a woman, in its unconditional renunciation of her own rights, presupposes precisely that on the other side there is not an equal pathos, not an equal will to renunciation; for if both should renounce themselves from love, the result would be — well, I don’t know, maybe an

empty space? Woman wants to be taken, adopted as a possession, wants to be absorbed in the concept 'possession', 'pos- sessed'; consequently, she wants someone who takes, who does not himself give or give himself away; who on the contrary is supposed precisely to be made richer in 'himself' — through the increase in strength, happiness, and faith given him by the woman who gives herself. Woman gives herself away; man takes more — I do not believe one can get around this natural opposition through any social contracts or with the best will to justice, desirable as it may be not to remind oneself constantly how harsh, terrible, enigmatic, and immoral this antagonism is. For love, when one considers it in its perfect, fully developed state, is nature, and nature is eternally 'immoral'. Faithful- ness is then implicit in woman's love, and follows from its definition; in a man's case it could perhaps arise as a consequence of his love, for instance as gratitude or as an idiosyncrasy of taste, a so-called 'elective affinity', but it does not belong to the essence of his love. Indeed this is so little the case that one might almost speak with some justification of a natural back-and-forth between love and faithfulness in a man: his love is desire for possession and not a renunciation or giving away, but with possession desire for possession always ceases . . . In fact it is the highly refined and suspicious thirst for possession on the part of a man who rarely and only after a long time admits that he has 'possession', which allows his love to endure. Thus it is possible that his love continues to grow even after surrender — he will not easily admit that a woman has nothing more to 'give up' to him. 228 Book Five: We Fearless Ones 364 The hermit speaks. — The art of dealing with people depends essentially on the skill (requiring much practice) to accept and eat a meal prepared in a kitchen you don't trust. If you come to the table ravenous, all is easy ('the worst company makes itself felt? — as Mephistopheles says);*° but one is never that hungry when one needs to be! Oh, how hard it is to digest one's fellow men! First principle: as in the face of misfortune, to engage your courage, to spring boldly to action, to admire yourself in the process, to sink your teeth into your reluctance, to swallow your disgust. Second principle: to 'improve' your fellow man, e.g. by praising him so as to make him start sweating out his pleasure in himself, or by taking hold of a corner of his good or 'interesting' qualities and pulling at it until all the virtue comes out and you can hide your fellow man in its folds. Third principle: self-hypnosis. To fixate on your object of association as if on a glass button until you stop feeling pleasure and displeasure in this activity and fall asleep without noticing it, become rigid, and attain equanimity: a home remedy amply tested in marriage and friendship, praised as indispensable but not yet scientifically analysed. Its popular name is — patience. 365 The hermit speaks again, — We, too, deal with 'people'; we, too, modestly don the cloak in which (as which) others know us, respect us, seek us, and so we appear in company, i.e. among others who are disguised but don't want to admit it. Like all

clever masks we, too, politely prop up a chair against the door when confronted with curiosity about anything but our 'cloak'. But there are other ways and tricks for 'wandering amongst', for 'associating with', people: for instance, as a ghost — which is highly advisable if one desires to get rid of them quickly and make them afraid. Example: others reach for us and can't get a hold of us. That's frightening. Or we enter through a closed door. Or when all the lights are out. Or when we're already dead. The latter is the trick of posthumous people par excellence. ("And what were you thinking?' one of them once said impatiently; 'Would we wish to endure this 36 Goethe, *Faust I*, line 1637; the line continues: '... that you are a human being among humans'. 229 The Gay Science

estrangement, coldness, and sepulchral silence enveloping us, this entire subterranean, hidden, mute, undiscovered loneliness that we call life but might as well be called death unless we knew what will become of us and that it is only after death that we come into our life and become alive — oh, very much alive, we posthumous ones!) 366 Faced with a scholarly book. — We are not among those who have ideas only between books, stimulated by books — our habit is to think outdoors, walking, jumping, climbing, dancing, preferably on lonely mountains or right by the sea where even the paths become thoughtful. Our first question about the value of a book, a person, or a piece of music is: 'Can they walk?' Even more, 'Can they dance?' We rarely read; but are none the worse on that account — and oh, how quickly we guess how someone has come to his ideas; whether seated before the inkwell, stomach clenched, head bowed over the paper; and oh, how soon we're done with his book! Cramped intestines betray themselves — you can bet on it — no less than stuffy air, closed ceilings, cramped spaces. — Those were my feelings just now as I closed a decent, scholarly book — grateful, very grateful, but also relieved . . . In a scholar's book there is nearly always something oppressive, oppressed: the 'specialist' emerges somehow — his eagerness, his seriousness, his ire, his overestimation of the nook in which he sits and spins, his hunchback — every specialist has his hump. Every scholarly book also reflects a soul that has become crooked; every craft makes crooked. Look at the friends of your youth again, after they have taken possession of their speciality (*Wissenschaft*) — Alas, in every case the reverse has also taken place! How they are now for all time possessed and obsessed by it! Grown into their corner, squashed beyond recognition, unfree, unstable, completely emaciated and jagged except for one spot that is paradigmatically round — one is moved and silenced when one sees them again that way. Above every craft, even one with a golden floor, is also a leaden ceiling that presses and presses on the soul until it becomes strangely and crookedly pressed. There is nothing to do about this. Don't think you can evade such crippling through some educational artifice. One pays dearly for any kind of mastery on earth, where perhaps one pays too dearly for everything; one is master of one's trade at the

price of also being its 230 Book Five: We Fearless Ones victim. But you want things to be different — ‘cheaper’, above all more comfortable — not so, my dear contemporaries? Well, if so, you instantly get something different: instead of the craftsman and master, you get the man of letters, the dexterous, ‘polydexterous’ literary man who of course lacks the hunched back — notwithstanding the posture he assumes before you as the shop attendant of spirit and the ‘bearer’ of culture — the literary man of letters, who really is nothing but who ‘represents’ nearly everything, who acts and ‘stands in for’ the expert, who takes it upon himself in all modesty to make himself paid, honoured, and celebrated in place of the expert. No, my scholarly friends, I bless you even for your hunched backs! And for despising, as do I, the ‘literary men’ and culture parasites! And for not knowing how to make a business of the spirit! And for having opinions that cannot be translated into monetary terms! And for not representing anything that you are wot! And because your only desire (Wille) is to become masters of your craft, with reverence for every type of mastery and competence and with ruthless rejection of anything specious, semi-genuine, mere- tricious, virtuoso-like, demagogical, or histrionic in litteris et artibus?” — of anything that cannot give you proof of its unconditional probity in discipline and prior training. (Not even genius can compensate for such a deficiency, however much it may blind people to it. One grasps this once one has watched our most talented painters and musicians up close, who nearly without exception manage through a cunning inven- tiveness of manners, stop-gap devices, and even principles, to acquire artificially and belatedly the appearance of such probity, such solidity of schooling and culture — without, of course, managing to deceive themselves, to silence forever their bad conscience. For surely you know? All great contemporary artists suffer from a bad conscience. . .) 367 The first distinction to draw regarding artworks. — Everything that is thought, written, painted, composed, even built and sculpted, belongs either to monologue art or to art before witnesses. The second category must also include the seemingly monologue art involving faith in God, the entire lyricism of prayer; for solitude does not yet exist to the pious 37 ‘in arts and letters’ 231 The Gay Science — this invention was first made by us, the godless. I know no deeper distinction in an artist’s entire optics than this: whether he views his budding artwork (‘himself’) from the eye of the witness, or whether he ‘has forgotten the world’, which is the essential feature of all monologue art — it is based on forgetting; it is the music of forgetting. 368 The cynic speaks. - My objections to Wagner’s music are physiological objections: why disguise them with aesthetic formulas? My ‘fact’ is that I stop breathing easily once this music starts affecting me; that my foot immediately gets angry at it and revolts — it has a need for tempo, dance, march; it demands chiefly from music the raptures found in good walking, striding, leaping, and dancing — but doesn’t my stomach protest, too?

My heart? My circulation? My intestines? Do I not unnoticeably grow hoarse as I listen? And so I ask myself: what does my whole body actually want from music? Its own relief; I believe, as if all animal functions should be quickened by easy, bold, exuberant, self-assured rhythms; as if iron, leaden life should be gilded by golden, good, tender harmonies. My melancholy wants to rest in the hiding-places and abysses of perfection: that's what I need music for. What is the drama to me! The cramps of its moral ecstasies that give the 'people' satisfaction! The whole hocus-pocus of gestures of the actor! You will guess that I am essentially anti-theatrical — but Wagner was, conversely, essentially a man of the theatre and an actor, the most enthusiastic mimomaniac that ever existed, also as a musician. And, incidentally, if it was Wagner's theory that 'the drama is the end; the music is always merely its means',^{>*} his practice was always, from beginning to end, 'the attitude is the end; the drama, and music, too, is always merely its means'. Music as a means of clarification, strengthening, internalization of the dramatic gesture and the actor's appeal to the senses; and the Wagnerian drama a mere occasion for many dramatic attitudes! Beside all other instincts, he had the commanding instinct of a great actor in absolutely everything — and, as I said, also as a musician. I once made this clear to an upright Wagnerian, with some trouble; and I had reasons to add: 'Do be a bit more honest with yourself — after all, we're not at 38 Wagner, Opera and Drama (1850~1), Introduction 232 Book Five: We Fearless Ones the theatre! At the theatre, one is honest only as a mass; as an individual one lies, lies to oneself. One leaves oneself at home when one goes to the theatre; one relinquishes the right to one's own tongue and choice, to one's taste, even to one's courage as one has it and exercises it within one's own four walls against god and man. No one brings the finest senses of his art to the theatre; nor does the artist who works for the theatre: there, one is people, public, herd, woman, pharisee, voting cattle, democrat, neighbour, fellow man; there, even the most personal conscience is vanquished by the levelling magic of the "greatest number"; there, stupidity breeds lasciviousness and is contagious; there, the "neighbour" reigns; there, one becomes a neighbour'. (I forgot to mention my enlightened Wagnerian's retort to the physiological objections: 'So, you simply aren't healthy enough for our music?') 369 Our coexistence. — Don't we have to admit to ourselves, we artists, that there exists an uncanny disparity within us; that in an odd way our taste and on the other hand our creative power stand each distinct from the other; each remains the way it is by itself, and each grows by itself; I mean each of these has completely different degrees and tempi of old, young, ripe, overblown, rotten? A musician, for instance, could spend a lifetime creating things that contradict what his spoiled listener's ear, listener's heart values, savours, prefers — he needn't even be aware of this contradiction! As experience shows with almost embarrassing regularity, one's taste can easily outgrow the taste of one's

powers, even without thereby paralysing them and hindering their continued productivity. But the opposite can happen, too — and this is precisely what I'd like to call artists' attention to. A perpetually creative person, a 'mother' type in the grand sense of the term, someone who doesn't hear or know anything but the pregnancies and child-beds of his spirit anymore, who simply has no time to reflect on himself and on his work and to make comparisons, who no longer wants to exercise his taste and simply forgets it, i.e. lets it stand, lie, or fall — maybe such a person would finally produce works that far excel his own judgement, so that he utters inanities about them and himself — utters them and believes them. This seems to me to be almost the norm among fertile artists — nobody knows a child less well than his parents — and this is true, to take a colossal 233 The Gay Science example, even in the case of the whole world of Greek art and poetry: it never 'knew' what it had done. 370 What is romanticism? — It may be recalled, at least among my friends, that initially I approached the modern world with a few crude errors and over-estimations and, in any case, with hope. I understood — on the basis of who knows what personal experiences? — the philosophical pessimism of the nineteenth century as if it were a symptom of a higher force of thought, of more audacious courage, and of more victorious fullness of life than had characterized the eighteenth century, the age of Hume, Kant, Condillac,*? and the sensualists: thus, tragic insight struck me as the distinctive /exury of our culture, its most precious, noblest and most dangerous squandering; but still, in view of its over-richness, as its permitted luxury. Similarly, I explained German music to myself as the expression of a Dionysian might of the German soul: I believed I heard in it the earthquake through which some pent-up primordial force is finally released — indifferent about whether it sets everything else which is called culture atremble.*° You see that what I misjudged both in philosophical pessimism and in German music was what constitutes its actual character — its romanticism. What is romanticism? Every art, every philosophy can be considered a cure and aid in the service of growing, struggling life: they always presuppose suffering and sufferers. But there are two types of sufferers: first, those who suffer from a superabundance of life —~ they want a Dionysian art as well as a tragic outlook and insight into life; then, those who suffer from an impoverishment of life and seek quiet, stillness, calm seas, redemption from themselves through art and insight, or else intoxication, paroxysm, numbness, madness. All romanticism in art and in knowledge fits the dual needs of the latter type, as did (and do) Schopenhauer and Richard Wagner, to name the most famous and prominent romantics that I misunderstood at the time — not, incidentally, to their disadvantage, one might in all fairness concede. He who is richest in fullness of life, the Dionysian god and man, can allow himself not only the sight of what is terrible and questionable but also the terrible deed and every luxury of 39 French empiricist philosopher

(1715-80) 40 Nietzsche expressed these views in *The Birth of Tragedy from the Spirit of Music* (1872). 234 Book Five: We Fearless Ones destruction, decomposition, negation; in his case, what is evil, non-sensical, and ugly almost seems acceptable because of an overflow in procreating, fertilizing forces capable of turning any desert into bountiful farmland. Conversely, he who suffers most and is poorest in life would need mainly mildness, peacefulness, goodness in thought and in deed — if possible, also a god who truly would be a god for the sick, a ‘saviour’; as well as logic, the conceptual comprehensibility of existence ~— for logic soothes, gives confidence — in short, a certain warm, fear-repelling narrowness and confinement to optimistic horizons. Thus I gradually came to understand Epicurus, the antithesis of a Dionysian pessimist, and equally the ‘Christian’, who really is simply a kind of Epicurean and, like him, essentially a romantic; and my vision grew keener for that most difficult and insidious form of backward inference with which the most mistakes are made — the inference from the work to the maker, from the ideal to the one who needs it, from every manner of valuation to the commanding need behind it. Nowadays I avail myself of this primary distinction concerning all aesthetic values: in every case I ask, ‘Is it hunger or superabundance that have become creative here?’ At first glance, a different distinction may appear more advisable — it’s far more noticeable — namely, the question of whether the creation was caused by a desire for fixing, for immortalizing, for being, or rather by a desire for destruction, for change, for novelty, for future, for becoming. However, both types of desires prove ambiguous upon closer examination, and can be interpreted under the first scheme, which seems preferable to me. The desire for destruction, for change and for becoming can be the expression of an overflowing energy pregnant with the future (my term for this is, as is known, ‘Dionysian’); but it can also be the hatred of the ill-constituted, deprived, and underprivileged one who destroys and must destroy because what exists, indeed all existence, all being, outrages and provokes him. To understand this feeling, take a close look at our anarchists. The will to immortalize also requires a dual interpretation. It can be prompted, first, by gratitude and love; art of such origin will always be an art of apotheosis, dithyrambic perhaps like Rubens;*! blissfully mocking like Hafis;4? bright and gracious like Goethe, spreading a Homeric light and splendour over all things. But it 41 Flemish Baroque painter (1577~1640)

Persian lyric poet of the fourteenth century; especially well-known in Germany because of

Goethe's great partiality for his poetry 235 The Gay Science can also be the tyrannical will of someone who suffers deeply, who struggles, is tortured, and who would like to stamp as a binding law and compulsion what is most personal, singular, narrow, the real idiosyn- crasy of his suffering, and who as it were takes revenge on all things by forcing, imprinting, branding Ais image on them, the image of his torture. The latter is romantic pessimism in its most expressive form, be it Schopenhauer's philosophy of will or Wagner's music — romantic pessimism, the last great event in the fate of our culture. (That there could be a completely different pessimism, a classical one — this intuition and vision belongs to me as inseparable from me, as my *proprium**® and *ipsissimum*;4 only the word 'classical' offends my ears; it has become far too trite, round, and indistinct. I call this pessimism of the future — for it is coming! I see it coming! — Dionysian pessimism.) 37! We incomprehensible ones. — Have we ever complained about being misunderstood, misjudged, misidentified, defamed, misheard, and ignored? This is precisely our lot — oh, for a long time yet! Let's say until 1901, to be modest — this is also our distinction; we wouldn't honour ourselves enough if we wanted it otherwise. We are misidentified — for we ourselves keep growing, changing, shedding old hides; we still shed our skins every spring; we become increasingly younger, more future-oriented, taller, stronger; we drive our roots ever more power- fully into the depths — into evil — while at the same time embracing the heavens ever more lovingly and broadly, and absorbing their light ever more thirstily with all our sprigs and leaves. Like trees we grow — it's hard to understand, like all life! ~ not in one place, but everywhere; not in one direction, but upwards and outwards and inwards and down- wards equally; our energy drives trunk, branches, and roots all at once; we are no longer free to do anything individual, to be anything individual . . . This is our lot, as I have said: we grow in height; and even if this should be our dark fate — for we dwell ever closer to the lightning! — well, we do not honour it less on that account; it remains that which we do not want to share, to impart: the dark fate of height, our fate. 4 "my) own" + "(my) ownmost" 236 Book Five: We Fearless Ones 372 Why we are not idealists. — Formerly, philosophers feared the senses: is it possible that we have unlearned this fear all too much? Today we are all sensualists, we philosophers of the present and future, #o¢ in theory but in praxis, in practice. The former, however, saw the senses as trying to lure them away from their world, from the cold kingdom of 'ideas', to a dangerous Southern isle where they feared their philosophers' virtues would melt away like snow in the sun. 'Wax in the ear' was virtually a condition of philosophizing; a true philosopher didn't listen to life insofar as life is music;

he denied the music of life — it is an old philosopher's superstition that all music is siren-music. Today we are inclined to make the opposite judgement (which could itself be just as mistaken), namely, that ideas are worse seductresses than the senses, for all their cold, anaemic appearance and not even despite that appearance — they always lived off the 'blood' of the philosopher; they always drained his senses and even, if you believe it, his 'heart'. These old philosophers were heartless: philosophizing was always a kind of vampirism. When considering such figures, including even Spinoza, don't you feel something deeply enigmatic and strange? Don't you see the spectacle unfolding, this steady growing paler — this ever more ideally construed desensualization? Don't you sense in the background some long-concealed blood-sucker who starts with the senses and finally leaves behind and spares only bones and rattling? — I refer to categories, formulas, words (for, forgive me, what remained of Spinoza, *amor intellectualis dei*, is mere rattle, nothing more! What is *amor*; what *deus*, when they are missing every drop of blood?). In sum: all philosophical idealism until now was something like an illness, except where, as in Plato's case, it was the caution of an overabundant and dangerous 45 If Nietzsche is trying to draw a distinction here between 'praxis' and 'practice', rather than just rhetorically repeating himself, it is not clear what the distinction is. In *Odyssey* Book x Odysseus tells how he outwitted the sirens, female singers who lure passing sailors to their death by singing irresistibly. He says he had himself bound to the mast of his ship so that he could hear the song, but could not do anything self-destructive, and that he had the ears of his crew stopped with wax so that they didn't hear the song at all, and continued to row undisturbed. Nietzsche refers to this story again in *Beyond Good and Evil* § 230, where he speaks, very puzzlingly, of man standing 'before the rest of nature, with intrepid Oedipus eyes and sealed Odysseus ears. . . 'Odysseus' ears were not sealed ~— but equally, Oedipus' eyes, at the end, could not see, 47 Intellectual love of god'; see *Ethics*, Book v, props. 32—37. 46 237 The Gay Science health; the fear of overpowerful senses; the shrewdness of a shrewd Socratic. - Maybe we moderns are not healthy enough to need Plato's idealism? And we don't fear the senses because — 373 'Science' as prejudice. — It follows from the laws that govern rank-ordering (*Rangordnung*) that scholars, insofar as they belong to the intellectual middle class, are not even allowed to catch sight of the truly great problems and question marks; moreover, their courage and eyes simply don't reach that far — and above all, the need that makes them scholars, their inner expectations and wish that things might be such and such, their fear and hope, too soon find rest and satisfaction. What makes, for instance, the pedantic Englishman Herbert Spencer* rave in his own way and makes him draw a line of hope, a horizon which defines what is desirable; that definitive reconciliation of 'egoism and altruism' about which he spins fables — this almost nauseates the likes of us: a

human race that adopts as its ultimate perspective such a Spencerian perspective would strike us as deserving of contempt, of annihilation! But that he had to view as his highest hope what to others counts and should count only as a disgusting possibility is a question mark that Spencer would have been unable to foresee. So, too, it is with the faith with which so many materialistic natural scientists rest content: the faith in a world that is supposed to have its equivalent and measure in human thought, in human valuations — a ‘world of truth’ that can be grasped entirely with the help of our four-cornered little human reason — What? Do we really want to demote existence in this way to an exercise in arithmetic and an indoor diversion for mathematicians? Above all, one shouldn’t want to strip it of its ambiguous character: that, gentlemen, is what good taste demands — above all, the taste of reverence for everything that lies beyond your horizon! That the only rightful interpretation of the world should be one to which you have a right; one by which one can do research and go on scientifically in your sense of the term (you really mean mechanistically?) ~ one that 48 English social thinker (1820~1903) who combined evolutionary beliefs with a form of utilitarianism; he believed that human history would lead to an ideal state in which egoism and altruism were reconciled. 238 Book Five: We Fearless Ones permits counting, calculating, weighing, seeing, grasping, and nothing else — that is a crudity and naiveté, assuming it is not a mental illness, an idiocy. Would it not be quite probable, conversely, that precisely the most superficial and external aspect of existence — what is most apparent; its skin and its sensualization ~~ would be grasped first and might even be the only thing that let itself be grasped? Thus, a ‘scientific’ interpretation of the world, as you understand it, might still be one of the stupidest of all possible interpretations of the world, i.e. one of those most lacking in significance. This to the ear and conscience of Mr Mechanic, who nowadays likes to pass as a philosopher and insists that mechanics is the doctrine of the first and final laws on which existence may be built, as on a ground floor. But an essentially mechanistic world would be an essentially meaningless world! Suppose one judged the value of a piece of music according to how much of it could be counted, calculated, and expressed in formulas — how absurd such a ‘scientific’ evaluation of music would be! What would one have comprehended, understood, recognized? Nothing, really nothing of what is ‘music’ in it! 374 Our new ‘infinite’. — How far the perspectival character of existence extends, or indeed whether it has any other character; whether an existence without interpretation, without ‘sense’, doesn’t become ‘non- sense’; whether, on the other hand, all existence isn’t essentially an interpreting existence — that cannot, as would be fair, be decided even by the most industrious and extremely conscientious analysis and self-examination of the intellect; for in the course of this analysis, the human intellect cannot avoid seeing itself under its perspectival forms, and solely in these. We

cannot look around our corner: it is a hopeless curiosity to want to know what other kinds of intellects and perspectives there might be; e.g. whether other beings might be able to experience time backwards, or alternately forwards and backwards (which would involve another direction of life and a different conception of cause and effect). But I think that today we are at least far away from the ridiculous immodesty of decreeing from our angle that perspectives are permitted only from this angle. Rather, the world has once again become infinite to us: insofar as we cannot reject the possibility that 1 includes infinite 239 The Gay Science interpretations. Once again the great shudder seizes us — but who again would want immediately to deify in the old manner this monster of an unknown world? And to worship from this time on the unknown (das Unbekannte) as ‘the Unknown One’ (den Unbekannten)? Alas, too many ungodly possibilities of interpretation are included in this unknown; too much devilry, stupidity, foolishness of interpretation — our own human, all too human one, even, which we know. . . 375 Why we seem to be Epicureans. — We are cautious, we modern men, about ultimate convictions; our mistrust lies in wait for the enchantments and deceptions of the conscience involved in every strong faith, every unconditional Yes and No. How can this be explained? Maybe what is to be found here is largely the caution of ‘once bitten, twice shy’; of the disappointed idealist; but there is also another, superior component: the gleeful curiosity of the one who used to stand in the corner and was driven to despair by his corner and who now delights and luxuriates in the opposite of a corner, in the boundless, in ‘the free as such’. Thus an almost Epicurean bent of knowledge develops that will not easily let go of the questionable character of things; also an aversion to big moral words and gestures; a taste that rejects all crude, four-square oppositions and is proudly aware of its practice in entertaining doubts. For this constitutes our pride, this slight tightening of the reins as our urge for certainty races ahead, this self-control of the rider on his wildest rides — for we still ride spirited and fiery animals; and when we hesitate, it is danger least of all that makes us hesitate. 376 Our slow periods. — This is how all artists and people of ‘works’ feel, the motherly type: at every chapter of their lives — which is always marked by a work — they always think they’ve reached their goal; they would always patiently take death with the feeling ‘we are ripe for it’. This is not the expression of weariness — rather that of a certain autumnal sunniness and mildness that the work itself, the fact that the work has become ripe, always leaves behind in its creator. Then the pace of life 240 Book Five: We Fearless Ones slows down and becomes thick and flows like honey — to the point of a long fermata,”’ of the faith in the long fermata. 377 We who are homeless. ~ Among Europeans today there is no lack of those who have a right to call themselves homeless in a distinctive and honourable sense: it is to them in particular that I commend my secret wisdom and *gaya scienza*.° For their lot is

hard; their hope uncertain; it is a feat to invent a form of comfort for them — but to what avail! We children of the future — how could we be at home in this today! We are unfavourably disposed towards all ideals that might make one feel at home in this fragile, broken time of transition; as for its ‘realities’, we don’t believe they are /asting. The ice that still supports people today has already grown very thin; the wind that brings a thaw is blowing; we ourselves, we homeless ones, are something that breaks up the ice and other all too thin ‘realities’. . . We ‘conserve’ nothing; neither do we want to return to any past; we are by no means ‘liberal’; we are not working for ‘progress’; we don’t need to plug our ears to the market- place’s sirens of the future: what they sing — ‘equal rights’, ‘free society’, ‘no more masters and no servants’ — has no allure for us. We hold it absolutely undesirable that a realm of justice and concord should be established on earth (because it would certainly be the realm of the most profound levelling down to mediocrity and chinoiserie);>! we are de- lighted by all who love, as we do, danger, war, and adventure; who refuse to compromise, to be captured, to reconcile, to be castrated; we consider ourselves conquerors; we contemplate the necessity for new orders as well as for a new slavery — for every strengthening and enhancement of the human type also involves a new kind of enslavement — doesn’t it? With all this, can we really be at home in an age that loves to claim the distinction of being the most humane, the mildest, and most righteous age the sun has ever seen? It is bad enough that precisely when we hear these beautiful words, we have the ugliest misgivings. What we find in 49 Musical sign indicating that a note or pause may be held for longer than its value would usually prescribe 50 See above, footnote to p. 1. 51 European decorative style so called because it is intended to look Chinese. Because of the slight artistic value of much that was produced in this style it has the connotation of insignificant, insubstantial, vapid, frivolous. 241 The Gay Science them is merely an expression — and the masquerade — of a deep weakening, of weariness, of old age, of declining energies! What can it matter to us what sequins the sick may use to cover up their weakness? Let them parade it as their virtue; after all, there is no doubt that weakness makes us mild, so righteous, so inoffensive, so ‘humane’! The ‘religion of compassion’ to which one would like to convert us — oh, we know these hysterical litthe men and women well enough who today need just this religion as a veil and finery. We are no humanitarians; we should never dare to allow ourselves to speak of ‘our love of humanity’ — our type is not actor enough for that! Or not Saint-Simonist>? enough; not French enough. One really has to be afflicted with a Gallic excess of erotic irritability and enamoured impatience to approach humanity honestly with one’s lust ... Humanity! Has there ever been a more hideous old woman amongst all old women? (Unless it were ‘the truth’: a question for philosophers.) No, we do not love humanity; but on the other hand we are not nearly ‘German’ enough, in

the sense in which the word ‘German’ is constantly used nowadays, to advocate nationalism and racial hatred and to be able to take pleasure in the national scabies of the heart and blood poisoning with which European peoples nowadays delimit and barricade themselves against each other as if with quarantines. For that, we are too uninhibited, too malicious, too spoiled, also too well-informed, too ‘well-travelled’: we far prefer to live on mountains, apart, ‘untimely’, in past or future centuries, merely in order to avoid the silent rage to which we know we should be condemned as eyewitnesses of politics that are destroying the German spirit by making it vain and which are, moreover, petty politics — to keep its creation from falling apart again, doesn’t it need to plant it between two deadly hatreds? Mustn’t it desire the eternalization of the European system of many petty states? We who are homeless are too diverse and racially mixed in our descent, as ‘modern men’, and consequently we are not inclined to participate in the mendacious racial self-admiration and obscenity that parades in Germany today as a sign of a German way of thinking and that is doubly false and indecent among the people of the ‘historical sense’. In a word — and let this be our word of honour — we are good Europeans, the rich heirs of millennia of European spirit, with too many provisions but also too many obligations. As such, we 52 Referring to Claude-Henri Saint-Simon (1760~ 1825), a French utopian socialist 242 Book Five: We Fearless Ones have also outgrown Christianity and are averse to it — precisely because we have grown out of it, because our ancestors were Christians who in their Christianity were mercilessly upright: for their faith they willingly sacrificed possessions, blood, position, and fatherland. We — do the same. But for what? For our unbelief? For every kind of unbelief? No, you know better than that, my friends! The hidden Yes in you is stronger than all Nos and Maybes that afflict you and your age like a disease; and you must sail the seas, you emigrants, you too are compelled to this by — a faith! 378 ‘And become bright again’. — We who are generous and rich in spirit, who stand by the road like open wells with no intention to fend off anyone who feels like drawing from us — we unfortunately do not know how to defend ourselves where we want to: we have no way of preventing people from clouding us, from darkening us; the time in which we live throws into us what is most time-bound; its dirty birds drop their filth into us; its boys their knick-knacks; and exhausted wanderers who come to us to rest, their small and great miseries. But we will do what we have always done: we take down into our depths whatever one casts into us — for we are deep; we do not forget — and become bright again. . . 379 The fool’s interlude. - The writer of this book is no misanthrope; today one pays too dearly for hatred of man. In order to hate the way one formerly hated the human being, Timonically,*> wholly, without exception, with one’s whole heart, with the whole Jove of hatred, one would have to renounce contempt. And how much fine joy, how much patience, how much

graciousness even do we owe precisely to our contempt! Moreover, it makes us ‘God’s elect’: refined contempt is our taste and privilege, our art, our virtue perhaps, and we are the most modern of moderns. . . Hatred, in contrast, places people on a par, vis- a-vis; in hatred there is honour; finally, in hatred there is fear, an ample 53 Legendary Athenian misanthrope, who is the subject of Shakespeare’s Timon of Athens 243 The Gay Science good piece of fear. We fearless ones, however, we more spiritual men of this age, we know our advantage well enough to live without fear of this age precisely because we are more spiritual. We will hardly be decapi- tated, imprisoned, or exiled; not even our books will be banned or burned. The age loves the spirit; it loves and needs us, even if we should have to make clear to it that we are artists of contempt; that every association with human beings makes us shudder slightly; that for all our mildness, patience, congeniality, and politeness, we cannot persuade our noses to give up their prejudices against the proximity of a human being; that we love nature the less humanly it behaves, and art & fit is the artist’s escape from man or the artist’s mockery of man, or the artist’s mockery of himself. . . 380 ‘The wanderer’ speaks. ~ In order to see our European morality for once as it looks from a distance, and to measure it up against other past or future moralities, one has to proceed like a wanderer who wants to know how high the towers in a town are: he /eaves the town. “Thoughts about moral prejudices”, if they are not to be prejudices about prejudices, presuppose a position outside morality, some point beyond good and evil to which one has to rise, climb, or fly — and in the present case, at least a point beyond our good and evil, a freedom from everything ‘European’, by which I mean the sum of commanding value judgements that have become part of our flesh and blood. That one wants to go precisely out there, up there, may be a slight rashness, a peculiar and unreasonable ‘you must’ — for we seekers of knowledge also have our idiosyncrasies of ‘unfree will’ — the question is whether one really can get up there. This may depend on manifold conditions. Mainly, the question is how light or heavy we are — the problem of our ‘specific gravity’. One has to be very light to drive one’s will to knowledge into such a distance and, as it were, beyond one’s time; to create for oneself eyes to survey millennia and, moreover, clear skies in these eyes. One must have liberated oneself from many things that oppress, inhibit, hold down, and make heavy precisely us Europeans today. The human being of such a beyond who wants to catch a glimpse of the highest measures of value of his time must first of all ‘overcome’ this time in himself — this is the test of his strength — and consequently not only his time but also his aversion and 244 Book Five: We Fearless Ones opposition against this time, his suffering from this time, his untimeli- ness, his romanticism. 381 On the question of being understandable. - One does not only wish to be understood when one writes; one wishes just as surely mot to be under- stood. It is by no means necessarily an objection to a

book when anyone finds it incomprehensible: perhaps that was part of the author's intention — he didn't want to be understood by just 'anybody'. Every nobler spirit and taste selects his audience when he wants to communicate; in selecting it, he simultaneously erects barriers against 'the others'. All subtler laws of a style originated therein: they simultaneously keep away, create a distance, forbid 'entrance', understanding, as said above -- while they open the ears of those whose ears are related to ours. And let me say this amongst ourselves and about my own case: I want neither the inexperience nor the liveliness of my temperament to keep me from being understandable to you, my friends — not the liveliness, as much as it forces me to deal with a matter swiftly in order to deal with it at all. For I approach deep problems such as I do cold baths: fast in, fast out. That this is no way to get to the depths, to get deep enough, is the superstition of those who fear water, the enemies of cold water; they speak without experience. Oh, the great cold makes one fast! And incidentally: does a matter stay unrecognized, not understood, merely because it has been touched in flight; is only glanced at, seen in a flash? Does one absolutely have to sit firmly on it first? Have brooded on it as on an egg? Diu noctuque incubando, as Newton said of himself? At least there are truths that are especially shy and ticklish and can't be caught except suddenly — that one must surprise or leave alone. Finally, my brevity has yet another value: given the questions that occupy me, I must say many things briefly so that they will be heard even more briefly. For, as an immoralist, one needs to avoid corrupting innocents — I mean, asses and old maids of both sexes to whom life offers nothing but their innocence; even more, my writing should inspire, elevate, and encourage them to be virtuous. I can't imagine a funnier sight on earth than inspired old asses and maids who get aroused by the sweet 54 'sitting upon it day and night' 245 The Gay Science sentiments of virtue: and 'this I have seen' — thus spoke Zarathustra. Enough about brevity; things stand worse with my ignorance, which I don't try to hide from myself. There are hours when I am ashamed of it — to be sure, also hours when I am ashamed of this shame. Maybe we philosophers are all in a bad position regarding knowledge these days: science is growing, and the most scholarly of us are close to discovering that they know too little. But it would be even worse if things were different — if we knew too much; our task is and remains above all not to mistake ourselves for someone else. We are different from scholars, although we are inevitably also, among other things, scholarly. We have different needs, grow differently; have a different digestion: we need more; we also need less. There is no formula for how much a spirit needs for its nourishment; but if it has a taste for independence, for quick coming and going, for wandering, perhaps for adventures of which only the swiftest are capable, it would rather live free with little food than unfree and stuffed. It is not fat but the greatest possible

suppleness and strength that a good dancer wants from his nourishment —and I wouldn't know what the spirit of a philosopher might more want to be than a good dancer. For the dance is his ideal, also his art, and finally also his only piety, his 'service of God'. 382 The great health. - We who are new, nameless, hard to understand; we premature births of an as yet unproved future — for a new end, we also need a new means, namely, a new health that is stronger, craftier, tougher, bolder, and more cheerful than any previous health. Anyone whose soul thirsts to experience the whole range of previous values and aspirations, to sail around all the coasts of this 'inland sea' (Muttel/meer) of ideals, anyone who wants to know from the adventures of his own experience how it feels to be the discoverer or conqueror of an ideal, or to be an artist, a saint, a lawmaker, a sage, a pious man, a soothsayer, an old-style divine loner — any such person needs one thing above all — the great health, a health that one doesn't only have, but also acquires continually and must acquire because one gives it up again and again, and must give it up! . . . And now, after being on our way in this manner for a long time, we argonauts of the ideal — braver, perhaps, than is prudent and often suffering shipwreck and damage but, to repeat, 246 Book Five: We Fearless Ones healthier than one would like to admit, dangerously healthy; ever again healthy — it seems to us as if, in reward, we face an as yet undiscovered land the boundaries of which no one has yet surveyed, beyond all the lands and corners of the ideal heretofore, a world so over-rich in what is beautiful, strange, questionable, terrible, and divine that our curiosity and our thirst to possess it have veered beyond control — alas, so that nothing will sate us anymore! After such vistas and with such a burning hunger in our conscience and science, how could we still be satisfied with modern-day man? Too bad ~ but it's inevitable that we look at his worthiest goals and hopes with a seriousness which is difficult to maintain; maybe we don't even look at all any more. Another ideal runs before us, a peculiar, seductive, dangerous ideal to which we wouldn't want to persuade anyone, since we don't readily concede the right to it to anyone: the ideal of a spirit that plays naively, i.e. not deliberately but from overflowing abundance and power, with everything that was hitherto called holy, good, untouchable, divine; a spirit which has gone so far that the highest thing which the common people quite understandably accepts as its measure of value would signify for it danger, decay, debasement, or at any rate recreation, blindness, temporary self- oblivion: the ideal of a human, superhuman well-being and benevolence that will often enough appear inhuman — for example, when it places itself next to all earthly seriousness heretofore, all forms of solemnity in gesture, word, tone, look, morality, and task as if it were their most incarnate and involuntary parody — and in spite of all this, it is perhaps only with it that the great seriousness really emerges; that the real question mark is posed for the first time; that the destiny of the soul changes; the hand of the

clock moves forward; the tragedy begins. 383 Epilogue. ~ But as I finally slowly, slowly paint this gloomy question mark and am still willing to remind my readers of the virtues of reading in the right way — oh, what forgotten and unknown virtues! — it strikes me that I hear all around myself most malicious, cheerful, hobgoblin- like laughter: the spirits of my book are themselves descending upon me, pulling my ears and calling me to order. ‘We can’t stand it anymore’, they shout, ‘stop, stop this raven-black music! Are we not surrounded by bright mid-morning? And by soft ground and green 247 The Gay Science grass, the kingdom of the dance? Was there ever a better hour for gaiety? Who will sing us a song, a morning song, so sunny, so light, so full-fledged that it does not chase away the crickets*> but instead invites them to join in the singing and dancing? And even plain, rustic bagpipes would be better than the mysterious sounds, such bog-cries, voices from the crypt, and marmot whistles with which you have so far regaled us in your wilderness, my Mr. Hermit and Musician of the Future! °*® No! Not such sounds! Let us rather strike up more pleasant, more joyous tones!>7 Does it please you nom, my impatient friends? Well then, who wouldn’t like to please you? My bagpipes are already waiting; my throat, too ~ it may sound a bit rough, but put up with it; after all, we’re in the mountains. At least what you are about to hear is new; and if you don’t understand it, if you misunderstand the singer, what does it matter? This happens to be ‘the singer’s curse’. °® You will be able to hear his music and tune so much the better, and so much the better will you be able to dance to his pipe. Is that what you want? 55 Grille means both ‘cricket’ and ‘bad mood’. 56 Wagner referred to his own music as ‘the music of the future’. 57 from Schiller’s Ode to Joy, used in the choral conclusion to the fourth movement of Beethoven’s Ninth Symphony 58 Title of a ballad by Ludwig Uhland (1787-1862) 248 Appendix: Songs of Prince Vogelfrei To Goethe! The ever-enduring is merely your parable! God the all-blurring your fiction unbearable. . . World-wheel, the turning one spawns goals each day: Fate — sighs the yearning one, the fool calls it — play. World-play, the ruling one, blends truth and tricks: — The eternally fooling one blends us — in the mix! . . . Vogelfret is an archaic expression used to declare someone an outlaw, literally ‘free as a bird’, and therefore not to be sheltered. In German the v and fare both pronounced as f, adding alliteration to this name and the title Nietzsche makes of it. ‘Prince Vogelfrei’ here functions as Nietzsche’s nom de guerre or pseudonym. Nietzsche is here parodying the ‘Chorus Mysticus’ which concludes Goethe’s Faust. At issue are the poet’s need to fictionalize, and Goethe’s elevation of womanhood to a metaphysical ‘eternal feminine’. In Faust, the ‘eternal feminine’ (das Ewig-Weibliche) represented by the blessed Gretchen succeeds in helping to redeem Faust, and to pull him up into heaven: ‘Woman Eternal / Draws us on high’ (“Das Ewig-Weibliche / Zieht uns hinan”) (lines 12110~12111 of Faust). 249 The Gay Science Poet’s Calling Stopped to rest one day, while

walking, seated under shady trees, when I heard a ticking tocking dainty rhythm on the breeze. I grew angry — made some faces — but I lost my anger quick and, as if in poet's paces, started speaking tick tock tick. As I sat, my verses making, syllables and sounds did pour, till I burst out laughing, shaking for a quarter hour or more. You a poet? You a poet? Is your mind no longer good? "Yes, my man, you are a poet" shrugs the pecker in the wood. Whom do I await in bushes? Whom do I, a robber, stalk? Proverb? Image? My rhyme rushes after it and makes it talk. Anything that moves, you know it serves to fuel my poet's mood. "Yes, my man, you are a poet" shrugs the pecker in the wood. Rhymes, I think, must be like arrows: when they pierce the lizard's heart, how he twitches, how it harrows, how he leaps in fits and starts! Wretched creatures, full of woe, it kills you or it boils your blood! "Yes, my man, you are a poet" shrugs the pecker in the wood. Crooked proverbs full of hurry, drunken wordlets how you throng! See each word and sentence scurry to the tick tock chain so long. Worthless souls who can't forgo it 250 Appendix: Songs of Prince Vogelfrei find it fun? Are poets crude? "Yes, my man, you are a poet" shrugs the pecker in the wood. Do you mock me feathered joker? Mentally I'm in rough shape, might my feelings too be broken? Fear my rage you jackanapes! Still, the poet rhymes — and though it spoiled his mood 'twas all he could. "Yes, my man, you are a poet" shrugs the pecker in the wood. In the South I perch now midst the crooked arbour and leave my weariness to sway. A bird enticed me to this harbour, within this nest I cool my ardour. Yet where am I? Away! Away! The sleeping sea, its colour fleeting, a purple sail, pure indolence. Rocks, fig trees, spires and harbour meeting, around me idylls, sheep are bleating — absorb me, southern innocence! Just step by step — that is not living, the German stride's too dull for me. I asked the wind to lift me heaving, with birds I soared without misgiving, ~ and south J flew across the sea. Reason! A grim preoccupation, too soon it brings us all the way! In flight I saw my limitation, — now juices flow for new creation, for life renewed and dawn of play... It's wise to think in solitary, but sing alone? — There wisdom ends! I've come to sing your praises merry, be still, sit down, and with me tarry my little birds, my naughty friends! 251 The Gay Science So young so false and so beguiling, it seems love looks upon me smiling and offers ev'ry charm of youth? Up north — I say it though I waver — I loved a crone so old I quaver: this woman bore the name of 'truth'... Pious Beppa As long as I'm curvaceous, being pious is no test. To young girls God is gracious, he loves the cute ones best. He will forgive the friar, forgive him certainly that he, like other friars, so wants to be with me. He is no grey church father! No, young and full of sap, hung over he'll still bother to play the jealous chap. I do not love the ageing, he does not love the old: How wondrous and engaging when God's designs unfold! The Church, it knows of living, it checks us thoroughly. And always it's forgiving ~ who would not pardon me! One whispers low and steady, one kneels and wipes

at tears, and when the new sin's ready the old one disappears. Praise God who loves a maiden as pretty as she lives, his heart by sin is laden, which he himself forgives. As long as 'm curvaceous, being pious is no test: 252 Appendix: Songs of Prince Vogelfrei When old and unsalacious, the devil take the rest! The Mysterious Bark? Yesternight, all were asleep, how the wind with steps uncertain sighing through the streets did creep. Rest was not in pillow, curtain, poppy, slumber potion deep, nor good conscience — which unburdens. Finally I left my bed, dressed and ran down to the shoreline. Tender mild the night — I met man and bark on sand in moonshine, sleepy both, the man and pet: — Sleepily the bark took to the brine. Just one hour, more than one, or was it a year? — my thinking and all feeling left me, sinking down to timeless tedium. Chasms opened, I stood shrinking, bounds dissolved: — then it was done! ~ Morning came: On blackness seeping rests a bark, it rides the swell... What took place? Thus crying, weeping hundreds ask: what was this? Hell? — Nothing happened! We were sleeping, sleeping all — so well, so well. Declaration of Love (whereby however the poet fell into a ditch) Oh wonder! Does he fly? He climbs aloft, and yet his pinions rest? What lifts and bears him high? What are his goal and course and limit's test? 2 Cf. Nietzsche's dithyramb 'The Sun Sets' ('Die Sonne sinkt') for the motif of the mysterious bark or skiff. 253 The Gay Science Star and eternity, he lives now in the heights that living shuns, forgives all jealousy —: Who see him fly, they too are soaring ones! Oh albatross! I know that to the heights J am forever lured. I thought of you: tears flow and do not cease — I love you noble bird! Song of a Theocritical Goatherd? I lie here, stomach aching, with bed bugs in my pants. Close by, the noise they're making! Thear it, how they dance... She was supposed to slip away and join me as my lover. I wait here like a stray — there's no sign of her. She promised she would come, how could she be untrue? — Does she chase everyone like my old goats do? That silken dress, pray tell! Proud girl, have you been good? Does more than one buck dwell in this little wood? ~ Lethally love makes us wait, it burns, it hardens! As hot nights germinate toadstools in gardens. Love eats away at me like seven deadly sins — [I'll never eat again. Farewell, dear onions! 3 The Greek poet Theocritus (third century BC) is considered the father of pastoral poetry. A 'theocritical' goatherd, using word play, is thus both pastoral and critical of God (theo). This poem, with its terse irony and irregular meter, reminds one of the lyrics of Heinrich Heine, Nietzsche's favourite lyric poet. 254 Appendix: Songs of Prince Vogelfrei The moon sets in the sea, and stars fade from the sky. Grey dawn comes 'round for me — I just want to die. 'These Vacillating People' People who are vacillating make my anger flame. When they honour they are hating, all their praise is self-contempt and shame. I'm not bound by their convention as I wander free, in their gaze is apprehension, poison-laced their hopeless jealousy. May they curse me all to blazes, spit for all to see!

Though they seek with helpless gazes, none will ever find their mark in me. Fool in Despair* Oh! What I wrote on board and wall with foolish heart and foolish scrawl, was meant to help me decorate. . . But you say: ‘Foolish hands desecrate — and we the walls must expurgate, remove all traces big and small!’ Allow me! This I can enjoy ~ I’ve wielded sponge and broom for all as critic and as water boy. But, when [ve finished your employ, Task you, you of super wit, your wisdom on the walls to sh—. * ‘Narrenhande beschmieren Tisch und Wände’, literally ‘a fool’s hands smear table and walls’, is a German proverb to the effect that clumsy people make a mess. 255 The Gay Science Rimus remedium, or: How sick poets console themselves? Time is dour, a witch who drools incessantly, drips hour upon hour. In vain, disgust cries out of me: ‘Curse, curse the power of eternity!’ World — brazen hard: A glowing bull — it hears no moan. Pain shoots through me and bores like a dart into my bone: ‘World has no heart, and stupid he, who’d therefore groan!’ Your poppies pour, pour, fever! poison in my brain! Too long already you bring me pain. What would you ask? What? ‘For what reward?’ ~ Ha! Curse the whore And her disdain! No! Please don’t go! Outside it’s cold, I hear it raining — I’ll cherish you without complaining. ~ Here! Take my gold: it glitters so! — ‘Happiness’ — No? Fever is sustaining? — The door panes fly! Rain lashes in, to my bed it climbs! The lamp blows out — havoc is nigh! ~ Who did not own a hundred rhymes, betimes, betimes, Would surely die! 5 Latin for ‘rhyme as remedy’. Compare the dithyramb ‘Ariadne’s Lament’ from Nietzsche’s collection of poems entitled Dionysus Dithyrambs. In Zarathustra, the poem is featured in Part IV as the song of the magician. Ariadne, lover of Theseus, is abandoned by the Greek hero, even though she rescued him from the labyrinth of the Minotaur by weaving a thread for him to follow. The ‘glowing bull’ refers to Phalaris of Agrigentum (570-554 BC), a tyrant who tortured his enemies by roasting them alive in a brazen bull. 256 Appendix: Songs of Prince Vogelfrei ‘My Happiness!’® I see again the pigeons of San Marco: The square is still, all bathed in sunny leisure. In gentle morn I idly let my songs flow like swarms of pigeons high into the azure — And still caress Them, tucking one more rhyme into their feathers — my happiness! You silent, blue-lit, silky heaven’s awning, protectively above the coloured stone I love, and fear, and envy — you are yawning . . . Indeed I’d drink its soul into my own! Would I let it egress? — No, silence, feast for eyes, in splendour dawning! ~ my happiness! You tower stern, with lion force ascending triumphantly, no effort, in full view! Across the square your throaty peal suspending — : In French you’d be its own accent aigu? To stay would be duress like yours, a bond of silken strands unending .. — my happiness! Go, music, go! Let shadows start preparing to grow into the brown and balmy night! Too early in the day for chimes, the flaring of gilded trim awaits a rosy light, Much does the day compress, much time for verses, prowling, secret sharing ~ my happiness! 6

The refrain of this poem, ‘mein Glick! Mein Glick!’ is an emphatic statement of the kind of happiness (Glick) Nietzsche enjoys, though in order to preserve the four beats I use ‘my happiness’ only once. 257 The Gay Science Toward New Seas’ Out there — thus I will; so doing trust myself now and my grip. Open lies the sea, its blueing swallows my Genoese ship. All things now are new and beaming, space and time their noon decree — : Only your eye — monstrous, gleaming stares at me, infinity! Sils-Maria® There sat I, waiting, waiting, — yet for naught, transcending good and evil, sometimes caught in light, sometimes caught in shadow, all game, all sea, all midday, all time without aim. At once then, my friend! One turned into Two — ~and Zarathustra strode into my view... To the Mistral. A Dance Song? Mistral wind, you rain-cloud reaper, sadness slayer, heaven sweeper blustering, how I love you! Are we not of one womb’s making, first born of one fate unbreaking, predetermined just we two? Here on stony pathways sliding Trun to you dancing, gliding, dancing as you pipe and sing: You without a ship and rudder, you as freedom’s freest brother, over raging seas do spring. 7 Nietzsche frequently used the figure of Columbus and the metaphor of seafaring to symbolize the courage of the human spirit. In The Gay Science § 289 he reminds us that the moral earth, too, is round, as an exhortation to explore the realm of morals just as earlier explorers had ventured around the globe. A draft of this poem was titled “To L.’ (Lou von Salome). 8 Sils Maria is a town in south-eastern Switzerland, in the Engadine valley, where Nietzsche spent his summers. 9 The mistral wind of southern France is a strong north wind. 258 Appendix: Songs of Prince Vogelfrei Scarce awake, I heard you calling, rushed to where the cliffs are falling golden walled into the sea. Hail! You came like rapids teeming, glitter bright and diamond gleaming from the peaks triumphantly. ’Cross the plains of heaven dashing I saw horses, hooves a-flashing, saw the carriage where you stand, saw your hand and how it quivered when it to the steeds delivered lightning-like the whip’s command, — Saw you toss the reins and plummet faster from your airy summit, diving like an arrow bright, glowing as the distance closes, like a ray of gold on roses struck by daybreak’s early light. On a thousand backs we’re dancing, billow-backs and backs of chancing — hail to dances nem, I say! Let us dance in every manner, free ~ so shall be ovr art’s banner, And our science — shall be gay! From each flower let us garner just one blossom for our honour, for our wreath just two leaves worth! Then like troubadours in riches we shall dance ’tween saints and bitches, dance our dance *tween God and Earth! He who cannot dance with twisters, bandages his wounds and blisters, bound and old and paralysed; he who reeks of sanctimony, honour-fools and virtues phony, out of our paradise! Let us whirl the dust in doses into sickly people’s noses, 259 The Gay Science let us shoo these sickly flies! This whole coast we must unshackle from their shrivel-breasted cackle, from these courage-vacant eyes! Let us chase the overcasters,

world maligners, rain-cloud pastors, let us tear the dark sky's veil! Let us roar. . . Free spirits' spirit, joy uplifts me when you're near, it makes me bluster like a gale! ~ — And to mark this joy forever, leave a will that time can't sever, take this wreath up where you are! Hurl it higher, further, madder, storm the sky on heaven's ladder, Hang it there — upon a star! 260 Index When an entry refers to a page on which more than one numbered section of the text appears, the section in question is indicated by an italicised numeral in parentheses. actions 151 (264), 173 (304) new domestic 177 (314) actors suffering from climate 178 as masters 216-17 anthropomorphism 109-10 musicians and 232-3 antipathy 144 (278) on the problem of 225-6 (367) antiquity add-on-liars, the 51 (29) essence of 227 Aeschylus 29 great men of 117 aesthetics 182, 235—6 science and virtue 119 agreement, law of xx, 77 (76) aphorisms vii—xi air, our 166—7 (293) Apollo 85 Ajax 125 appearance 69—70, 104, 231 Alcaeus 83 avoiding deception by 143 alcohol 58, 124, 129 the consciousness of 63 —4 (54) Alfieri, Vittorio, conte di 89 Greeks' worship of xii, 8-9 Algiers 174 and the problem of the actor 225-6 Allah 122 and 'thing in itself' 214 altruism applause 141 (207), 184—5 (330) and egoism 238 Archilochus of Paros 83 no 116 (179) architects 216 utility of 45 architecture amazement, our 59—60 (46) of Genoa 164—5 Americans 183, 216 for those who wish to pursue knowledge amor fati 157 159-60 (280) analogy xxi aristocracy see nobility anarchists 235 Ariston of Chios 116 ancients Aristotle 76, 80 and the art of reading well xx, 247-8 Armida 175 belief in dreams 132 Arouet, Francois Marie see Voltaire Andreas-Salomé, Lou xxiv arrogance, against 15 animals art criticism by 145 (224) after illness 7~9 female and male 75~6 and happiness 86, 88 with good conscience 77~8 (77) and life 170 mercy to 97 monologue 231-2 261 Index art (cont.) and nature 79-81 (80) our ultimate gratitude to 104-5 (707) and practical wisdom 114 romanticism in 234—6 and truth xix artistic, the, in Europe 215-17 (356) artists bad conscience of 231 cheerfulness for 8--9 coexistence 233-4 concept of, and the problem of the actor 225-6 of contempt ix, 243~4 (379) Germans as 103 (105) glorify by choice 86, 148 in love 69, 70-1 love of work 57, 75 offensive in the presentation 139 philosophy of 97 slow periods 240-1 as squanderers 141, 212 on the vanity of 87~8 (87) viewpoint 231-2 we 70~1 (59) what one should learn from 169-70 (299) and works 147 (247) artworks and the art of festivals 89 the first distinction to draw regarding 231-2 (367) asceticism xviii, 38, 123 Asclepius 194 Asians 58 aside 136 (174) Assua sect 174 atavism 36 (20) atheism, triumph of scientific 218-19 audience, selection of 245-6 Augier, Emile 46n Augustine, St 224 Augustus, Emperor 54 autobiography, warning against 89 (97) backward inference 235 bad, whom do you call? 152 (273) Bahnsen 220 Balsamo, Giuseppe see Cagliostro, Alessandro, conte di barbarians, vs. higher culture 94—5, 100-1 battles, new 109 (108), 112 Batz, Phillip (Mainlander') 220n Baubo 8 beautiful, the and the good 86 (85) beauty 193 Beethoven, Ludwig van roo

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Part VI

Thus Spoke Zarathustra

1883–1885 — *Translated by R.J. Hollingdale*

When Zarathustra was thirty years old, he left his home and Lake Urmi and went into the mountains. Here he had the enjoyment of his spirit and his solitude and he did not weary of it for ten years. But at last his heart turned – and one morning he rose with the dawn, stepped before the sun, and spoke to it thus: ‘Great star! What would your happiness be, if you had not those for whom you shine! You have come up here to my cave for ten years: you would have grown weary of your light and of this journey, without me, my eagle and my serpent; but we waited for you every morning, took from you your superfluity and blessed you for it. Behold! I am weary of my wisdom, like a bee that has gathered too much honey; I need hands outstretched to take it; I should like to give it away and distribute it, until the wise among men have again become happy in their folly and the poor happy in their wealth. To that end, I must descend into the depths: as you do at evening, when you go behind the sea and bring light to the underworld too, superabundant star! – like you, I must go down – as men, to whom I want to descend, call it. So bless me then, tranquil eye, that can behold without envy even an excessive happiness! Bless the cup that wants to overflow, that the waters may flow golden from him and bear the reflexion of your joy over all the world! Behold! This cup wants to be empty again, and Zarathustra wants to be man again.’ – Thus began Zarathustra’s down-going. (342). The sense of this passage is repeated in other words at the end of the above-quoted letter: ‘I don’t want to be lonely any more; I want to learn to be human again. Alas, in this field I have almost everything still to learn!’ Undoubtedly Nietzsche at this point identified himself with another ‘teacher’ who came down out of solitude around his fortieth year. The second point is that, after he was abandoned during the following October by Lou Salomé and had to realize that his hope of marrying her was definitely not going to be fulfilled, he fell into an abyss of despair. I am not underrating the emotional effect which such a disappointment might normally be expected to produce, but its effect on Nietzsche was certainly very violent indeed, especially considering that his disposition was usually a cheerful one. It should be recalled that he had been recurrently ill since 1871 – almost certainly a consequence of a syphilitic infection contracted when a student – and the inability of these attacks to depress him or do more than delay his work is a witness to the resilience of his

temperament. His failure with Lou, however, threw him for a time completely off balance – how far off balance can be gauged, for example, from this letter to Franz Overbeck, posted on Christmas Day 1882: I have suffered from the disgraceful and anguishing recollections of this past summer as from a kind of madness.... They involve a conflict of contrary emotions which I am not equal to....If only I could sleep! But the strongest sleeping-draughts help as little as do the six to eight hour walks I take. If I cannot find the magic formula to turn all this – muck to gold, I am lost.... I now mistrust everybody: I sense in everything I hear contempt towards me.... Sometimes I think of renting a small room in Basel, visiting you now and then and attending lectures. Sometimes I think of doing the opposite: of driving my solitude and resignation to the ultimate limit and – The ground of this violent reaction was, as other letters but especially Zarathustra show, the realization he was back in solitude and that he was going to stay there. With the benefit of hindsight we can see that by the turn of the year 1882–83 there had been assembled in Nietzsche the material for an explosion of some sort – or rather, as we shall discover, an eruption. Intellectually, emotionally and physically he was all but exhausted; but the ‘ideas’ of the summer of 1881 as they had received tentative expression in the fourth book of *The Gay Science* are preliminary rumblings which indicate what is coming. In January – ‘as a result of ten absolutely fresh and cheerful January days’ – the tension broke, inhibition gave way, and the first part of Zarathustra came furiously out. ‘Has anyone at the end of the nineteenth century a distinct conception of what poets of strong ages called inspiration?’ he asked in *Ecce Homo*, apropos of Zarathustra. If not, I will describe it. – If one had the slightest residue of superstition left in one, one would hardly be able to set aside the idea that one is merely incarnation, merely mouthpiece, merely medium of overwhelming forces. The concept of revelation, in the sense that something suddenly, with unspeakable certainty and subtlety, becomes viable, audible, something that shakes and overturns one to the depths, simply describes the fact. One hears, one does not seek; one takes, one does not ask who gives; a thought flashes up like lightning, with necessity, unflinchingly formed – I have never had any choice. An ecstasy whose tremendous tension sometimes discharges itself in a flood of tears, while one’s steps now involuntarily rush along, now involuntarily lag;...a depth of happiness in which the most painful and gloomy things appear, not as an antithesis, but as conditioned, demanded, as a necessary colour within such a superfluity of light;...Everything is in the highest degree involuntary but takes place as in a tempest of a feeling of freedom, of absoluteness, of power, of divinity. The involuntary nature of image, of metaphor is the most remarkable thing of all; one no longer has any idea what is image, what metaphor, everything presents itself as the readiest, the truest, the simplest means of expression. It really does seem, to allude to an expression of

Zarathustra's, as if the things themselves approached and offered themselves as metaphors... This is my experience of inspiration; I do not doubt that one has to go back thousands of years to find anyone who could say to me 'it is mine also'. Zarathustra again emerges from his ten-year solitude, but now the mankind to whom he wants to address himself rejects him and he turns from it; subsequently he deserts even the chosen few who have remained with him and goes back into solitude. His message to mankind is: I teach you the Superman. Man is something that should be overcome. And: The Superman is the meaning of the earth. Let your will say: The Superman shall be the meaning of the earth. And: All gods are dead: now we want the Superman to live – let this be our last will one day at the great noontide! Then: A table of values hangs over every people. Behold, it is the table of its overcomings; behold, it is the voice of its will to power. And (in the second part, written in a similar state of excitement in the following June and July): Of Self-Overcoming ... Where I found a living creature, there I found will to power... And life itself told me this secret: 'Behold,' it said, 'I am that which must overcome itself again and again Where there is perishing and the falling of leaves, behold, there life sacrifices itself – for the sake of power!... And you too, enlightened man, are only a path and footstep of my will: truly, my will to power walks with the feet of your will to truth!... The living creature values many things higher than life itself; yet out of this evaluation itself speaks – the will to power!'... And (in the third part, written in a state of even greater excitement in January 1884): O my Will!... Preserve me from all petty victories!... That I may one day be ready and ripe in the great noontide... a bow eager for its arrow, an arrow eager for its star – a star, ready and ripe in its noontide, glowing, transpierced... Spare me for one great victory! And: Sing and bubble over, O Zarathustra, heal your soul with new songs, so that you may bear your great destiny... behold, you are the teacher of the eternal recurrence ... And if you should die now, O Zarathustra: behold, we know too what you would then say to yourself... 'Now I die and decay... and in an instant I shall be nothingness... But the complex of causes in which I am entangled will recur – it will create me again!... I shall return... not to a new life or a better life or a similar life: I shall return eternally to this identical and self-same life... to teach once more the eternal recurrence of all things, to speak once more the teaching of the great noontide of earth and man, to tell man of the Superman once more... Finally: O Man! Attend! What does deep midnight's voice contend? 'I slept my sleep, And now awake at dreaming's end: The world is deep, Deeper than day can comprehend. Deep is its woe, Joy – deeper than heart's agony: Woe says: Fade! Go! But all joy wants eternity, –wants deep, deep, deep eternity!' And, in an immense expansion of this poem, written a year later: Did you ever say Yes to one joy? O my friends, then you said Yes to all woe as well. All things are chained and entwined together, all things are in love;

if you ever wanted one moment twice, if you ever said: ‘You please me, happiness, instant, moment!’ then you wanted everything to return! you wanted everything anew, everything eternal, everything chained, entwined together, everything in love, O that is how you loved the world, you everlasting men, loved it eternally, and for all time: and you say even to woe: ‘Go, but return!’ For all joy wants – eternity The Superman, the will to the Superman, the will to power and self-overcoming. Live dangerously! Amor fati , eternal recurrence, total affirmation of life. The great noontide. These are the slogans, the ‘signs’, by which Nietzsche surmounted his nihilism and resolved his crisis. 4 Let’s now try to get to the heart of this book and discover the real meaning of its central concepts. What is truth? said jesting Pilate; and would not stay for an answer. If he had stayed, what answer would he have received? There cannot be any doubt: Jesus would have said: I am the truth. This too is Zarathustra’s answer to the question ‘what is truth?’ For what, at this level, is truth, ‘the truth’? Isn’t it the discovery that no truth is discoverable except the truth which you yourself are? that there is no truth (sense, meaning) in the world except the truth (sense, meaning) you yourself give it ? that ‘truth’ is a concept belonging to the human mind and will and that apart from the human mind and will there is no such thing as ‘truth’? finally, that the resolute determination that your own truth shall be the truth is the sole origin of ‘the truth’ on earth? To give life a meaning: that has been the grand endeavour of all who have preached ‘truth’; for unless life is given a meaning it has none. At this level, truth is not something that can be proved or disproved: it is something which you determine upon , which, in the language of the old psychology, you will . It is not something waiting to be discovered, something to which you submit or at which you halt: it is something you create , it is the expression of a particular kind of life and being which has, in you, ventured to assert itself. Thus Zarathustra declares: ‘The Superman is the meaning of the earth. Let your will say: The Superman shall be the meaning of the earth.’ He is a prophet, not of the truth that is , but of the truth that shall be . What determines the nature of ‘truth’? The nature of the I which asserts ‘ I am the truth’. Why truth, and not rather untruth or indifference to truth? Because each particular life and being needs a fortress within which to preserve and protect itself and from which to reach out in search of aggrandizement and more power, and truth is this fortress. Or, as life says to thinking mankind: ‘my will to power walks with the feet of your will to truth.’ What then ultimately is the answer to Pilate’s question? It is: truth is will to power. Thus – by my reading at any rate – spoke Zarathustra. The great need, the ‘one thing needful’, was to overcome the nihilistic devaluation of life and man which had followed the destruction of the metaphysical world (the ‘death of God’). This devaluation had been effected chiefly by a psychological theory, namely the theory that primitive drives can be sublimated , so that distinctively human qualities, ‘humane’

qualities, can be understood as sublimated forms of drives which mankind has in common with the animals. The motive for formulating such a theory was the need to account for what is distinctively human without recourse to the metaphysical or supernatural. From a very large number of experiments, two primitive drives emerged as dominant: the desire for power and the emotion of fear. And when Nietzsche came to understand fear as the feeling of the absence of power, he was left with a single motivating principle for all human actions: the will to power. Sublimated will to power was now the Ariadne's thread tracing the way out of the labyrinth of nihilism. 'A table of values' – i.e. a morality – 'hangs over every people': it is the table of the self-imposed commands which have turned a herd and rabble into a nation: primitive aggression has been directed back upon itself, sublimated into self-control. When the same thing happens in an individual, when he imposes commands upon himself, and obeys them, so that he too as it were changes from a rabble into a nation, the result is 'the Superman', the man who is master of himself. But to master oneself is the hardest of all tasks, that which requires the greatest amount of power: he who can do it has experienced the greatest increase in power, and if (as Nietzsche later says explicitly but here implies) happiness (in Zarathustra 'joy') is the feeling that power increases, that a resistance is overcome, then the Superman will be the happiest man and, as such, the meaning and justification of existence. Through continual increase of power to transmute the chaos of life into a continual self-overcoming of life and thus to experience in an ever greater degree the joy which is synonymous with this self-overcoming: that would now be the meaning of life – for joy is to Nietzsche, as it is to commonsense, the one thing that requires no justification, that is its own justification. He who had attained that joy would affirm life and love it however much pain it contained, because he would know that 'all things are chained and entwined together' and that everything is therefore part of a whole which he must accept as a whole. To express this feeling of life-affirmation Nietzsche formulated a theorem of 'the eternal recurrence of the same events' to which he gave rhapsodic expression in Zarathustra. To be sure, only the Superman could be so well-disposed towards his life as to want it again and again for ever: but that precisely is the reason for willing his creation. The joy of the Superman in being as he is, now and ever, is the ultimate sublimation of the will to power and the final overcoming of an otherwise inexorable and inevitable nihilism.⁵ These conceptions constitute the heart of Thus Spoke Zarathustra; these, and the extended hymn to solitude and individuality to which the book owes its peculiar tone and pathos. I have described the process of their formation as an eruption; what I mean is an eruption from the subconscious of ideas belonging to Nietzsche's earliest years, an eruption brought about by the very fact that at this time he had arrived at the end of the path which led away from them. He could go no further forward, so he

had to go back. But since he likewise could not retract what he had been asserting for the previous five years, these earliest ideas which now came up again came up transformed and distorted almost beyond recognition. What is involved is the operation of something like the psychic censor of psychoanalysis: so that I doubt whether Nietzsche himself was altogether aware of the provenance of the grand and grandiose positive conceptions to the elaboration of which he began to apply his exceptional rhetorical gifts. These 'earliest ideas' are of course Christian, and specifically Lutheran. The teaching of Lutheran Pietism is before all that the events of life are divinely willed and that it is thus impiety to desire that things should be different from what they are: * but the other tenets of Christian belief are naturally also firmly adhered to by Lutherans. Here, without more ado, are what I take to be the Christian parallels to the conceptions which dominated Nietzsche's mind during the period from the summer of 1881 to the year January 1883–January 1884, when they found full expression in Zarathustra, Amor fati : Lutheran acceptance of the events of life as divinely willed, with the consequent affirmation of life as such as divine , as a product of the divine will, and the implication that to hate life is blasphemous. Eternal recurrence : as a consequence of amor fati the extremest formula of life-affirmation, strongly influenced by the Christian concepts of eternal life and the unalterable nature of God: what is, 'is now and ever shall be, world without end.' Will to power : divine grace. The clue to the connexion is the concept of 'self-overcoming', which is one of Nietzsche's terms for sublimation and the hinge upon which the theory of the will to power turns from being a nihilist to a positive and joyful conception. The corresponding Christian conception is that of unregenerate nature redeemed by the force of God's grace. In both conceptions the central idea is that a certain inner quality (grace/sublimated will to power) elevates man (or some men) above the rest of nature. The pathos with which 'will to power' is invested derives to some extent from 'Thy will be done' and the juxtaposition of 'power' and 'glory', together with the Christian doctrine that to God's will all things are possible. Live dangerously! : 'Take up thy Cross, and follow me' -Christian deprecation of the easy life. Great noontide : the Second Coming, the Last Judgement, the division of the sheep from the goats, the wheat from the chaff. Superman : God as creator and 'highest being', the 'Son of Man' as God, man as the receptacle of divine grace who rejoices at the idea of eternity: the embodiment and actualization of everything regarded as desirable. What the Christian says of God, Nietzsche says in very nearly the same words of the Superman, namely: 'Thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever and ever.' 6 Zarathustra's posture as inspired prophet and reader of riddles would itself suggest an atavism in Nietzsche's mind even if we were unable clearly to identify the earlier stage to which it had reverted. But it was an atavism whose effect was curative, like an electrical storm that breaks up the cloud and bad

weather which has caused it. The theme of joy in existence, of the self-sufficiency-in-joy of the sovereign individual, of this joyful self-sufficiency as the aim and meaning of life is what finally reigns as the paramount theme of the book: and this theme derives, not from the grand but ultimately overpowering and stifling conceptions of Christianity, but from someone Nietzsche was later to celebrate as an actualization of the Superman: Goethe. When the sound and wholesome nature of man acts as an entirety, when he feels himself in the world as in a grand, beautiful, worthy and worthwhile whole, when this harmonious comfort affords him a pure, untrammelled delight: then the universe, if it could be sensible of itself, would shout for joy at having attained its goal and wonder at the pinnacle of its own essence and evolution. For what end is served by all the expenditure of suns and planets and moons, of stars and Milky Ways, of comets and nebula, of worlds evolving and passing away, if at last a happy man does not involuntarily rejoice in his existence? This passage, from Goethe's essay on Winckelmann (1805), which Nietzsche certainly knew, could stand as the motto of Thus Spoke Zarathustra. It is the distillation of the great benevolent spirit of Goethe, a spirit Nietzsche called 'dionysian' and with which, for all its tremendous difference in emphasis, Zarathustra is in accordance. 7 I now offer a brief survey of Zarathustra chapter by chapter and comment on a few individual points about which the reader may like some enlightenment. Zarathustra (Greek Zoroastres) is the founder of the ancient Persian religion, and the book with which he is credited, the Zend-Avesta, is its Bible. Scholars of the nineteenth century questioned whether Zarathustra existed, as they questioned whether Homer existed (probably a side-effect of 'evolutionism'): both are now rehabilitated. Nietzsche protested at the dissolution of Homer: 'We gain nothing with our theory of the poetising soul of the people, we are always referred back to the poetical individual' (Homer and Classical Philology, 1869). So with Zarathustra. He is conjectured to have lived in the seventh century B.C. The heart of his religion is a conflict between Ahura Mazda (Ormuzd), the god of light and good, and Angra Mainyu (Ahriman), the god of darkness and evil. Nietzsche's explanation of why he appropriated his name for his own hero: I have not been asked, as I should have been asked, what the name Zarathustra means in precisely my mouth, in the mouth of the first immoralist: for what constitutes the tremendous uniqueness of that Persian in history is precisely the opposite of this. Zarathustra was the first to see in the struggle between good and evil the actual wheel in the working of things: the translation of morality into the realm of metaphysics, as force, cause, end-in-itself, is his work. But this question is itself at bottom its own answer. Zarathustra created this most fateful of errors, morality: consequently he must also be the first to recognise it. Not only has he had longer and greater experience here than any other thinker...what is more important is that Zarathustra is more truthful than any other thinker. His teaching,

and his alone, upholds truthfulness as the supreme virtue....To tell the truth and to shoot well with arrows : that is Persian virtue. – Have I been understood? The self-overcoming of morality through truthfulness, the self-overcoming of the moralist into his opposite – into me – that is what the name Zarathustra means in my mouth. (Em Homo). The book is very loosely constructed, but it does possess direction and a plot of sorts. PART ONE. Prologue , (1) Zarathustra comes down out of solitude, announces (2) that God is dead and (3) preaches God's successor, the Superman. Mankind fails to understand him, even when he (4) expounds his beatitudes (cf. Matthew 5, 3–11) and (5) appeals to their pride by describing the Superman's antithesis, the 'Ultimate Man', the man who sacrifices the future to his own present. The (6) overtoppling of the tightrope walker (mankind balanced over an abyss) by the buffoon (Zarathustra himself perhaps, an unannounced attraction) brings home to Zarathustra (7) that human existence is 'uncanny' (cf. the second chorus of Antigone : 'Many things are uncanny, but none more uncanny than man'), and after a bad night (8) he resolves (9) to desert the market place and speak his message only to the individual. The twenty-two 'discourses' which follow are addressed by Zarathustra to his band of disciples. Five of the discourses are enclosed in a miniature dramatic scene, the remainder are direct address. Each is an epitome of Nietzsche's views on the subject in question: 1: the 'education of the spirit': self-discipline, independence, creativity (for another account, in quite different language, see *Human, All Too Human* , Preface to volume I (1886), sections 3–7); 2: 'negative virtue', virtue which consists in not doing wrong and which has as its reward 'peace of soul'; 3: 'the metaphysical world' (including a renunciation of his earlier view (*The Birth of Tragedy* , 1872) that aesthetic values are the only true values); 4: the relation between mind and body (a prologue to the theory of the will to power); 5: the nature of virtue; 6: its opposite, the 'criminal instinct'; 7: aphorisms on authorship, happiness and laughter (introduces 'the Spirit of Gravity'); 8: 'nobility of soul'; 9: pessimism; 10: 'Live dangerously!'; II: the State; 12: nausea at mankind, 'l' enfer, c'est les autres'; 13: sensuality and its disguises; 14: how to be a true friend; 15: the relativity of moral values (introduces the will to power); 16: critique of 'love thy neighbour as thyself'; 17: the need for solitude and the danger of solitude; 18: the nature of women; 19: the nature of justice; 20: bad marriages and good ones; 21: bad deaths and good ones. Over all these discourses hovers Zarathustra's dictum 'Man is something that must be overcome.' The final chapter reverts to the Prologue, to the death of God and the need for the Superman to give significance to the earth; Zarathustra extols the magnanimous man, the man so full of strength and well-being he bestows gifts on others because he has to, and exhorts his disciples to independence. Then he leaves them. PART TWO. Much more various than Part One. Zarathustra is more of a dramatic character and eight of the twenty-two chapters involve action. 1: corresponds to the Prologue

of Part One: Zarathustra's return; 2: a much-expanded recapitulation of the 'God is dead' theme, and the reintroduction of the Superman as God's successor; 3: pity for mankind and the need to overcome it; 4: organized religion and the priesthood; 5: another essay on virtue, true and false; 6: another essay on nausea at mankind and how to avoid it; 7: another essay on justice and a polemic against revengefulness disguised as justice; 8: philosophy, true and false; 9–11: prose poems, autobiographical, for the most part fretful, plaintive, disgruntled (cf. Part Three 3–4 and 14–16); 12: the will to power in full; 13: resumes and completes 8; 14: critique of contemporary culture; 16: critique of the contemplative life and the search for 'pure knowledge'; 16: critique of the scholarly life; 17: critique of the artistic nature; 18: dramatically, the book's turning-point. A discourse on revolution and anarchism is allied to an uncommon amount of action and a fantastical story told by sailors. Zarathustra's disciples 'hardly listened' to his discourse, we are told, because of their anxiety to repeat the sailors' story, the point of which is that Zarathustra's alter ego has been seen flying through the air crying 'It is time! It is high time!' 'For what is it high time?' Zarathustra asks himself when he learns this: the answer (suppressed for the moment but henceforward never absent from his mind) is: 'Time to declare the eternal recurrence.'; 19: continues the fantastical atmosphere of 18 and intensifies it into nightmare; Zarathustra is now in a nervous and depressed condition very different from the state of ebullient optimism which has chiefly characterized him hitherto; a 'dark night of the soul', which persists into Part Three; 20: a discourse on 'great men' leads to reflexions on the nature of will in the midst of which Zarathustra is struck dumb when he realizes the implications of what he is saying for the theory of eternal recurrence; 21: on the desirability of masks – a beautifully shaped chapter, in this respect perhaps the finest; but it belongs in spirit earlier in the book, it interrupts the steady descent from 18 to 22, in which Zarathustra, as the consequence of a second nightmare which robs him of all self-confidence and almost of self-control, again deserts his disciples, this time, however, in a mood of profound misery, and this time for good. PART THREE. For the most part Zarathustra is alone and addressing himself. Earlier themes are taken up and woven into a texture which sometimes grows too tight. Imagery becomes clotted at times. But the intensity of expression aimed at is superbly achieved and maintained. 1: Zarathustra has just left his disciples and is making his way home, his depression still upon him; 2: on board ship, he expounds the eternal recurrence as a riddle and in language which recalls the nightmare of Part Two 18; although all is still shrouded in obscurity and mystery, that he has now brought himself to raise the veil even to this limited extent is sufficient to restore him to his normal cheerfulness; 3 and 4: prose poems, introspective, cheerful, calm; half way between the melancholy of Part Two 9–11 and the Dionysian ecstasy of Part Three 14–16; 5: back on firm land, Zarathustra

experiences again his familiar nausea at mankind; 6: self-portrait of Zarathustra as a solitary; 7: extended exegesis of the text 'May looking away be my only form of negation!'; 8: polemic against piety; 9: Zarathustra arrives back at his cave: a hymn to solitude; 10: a model 'revaluation' of three vices; n: exhortation to cheerfulness; 12–16: the climax of the book, a supreme exhibition of the sustained intellectual passion which gives Nietzsche his place among the world's great men. 12 is a re-exposition in brief of Zarathustra's teachings, up to but not including the theory of the eternal recurrence, which is reserved for 13, in which the theory is at last stated in full and without disguise, and joyfully accepted and embraced. With this act Zarathustra's self-education reaches its appointed end. The fulfilment is celebrated with a trilogy of prose poems, 14–16, of great exuberance and intensity. At this culmination of his course, Zarathustra is, as aforesaid, entirely alone, so that when he wishes to give vent to his feelings of unbounded joy and gratitude in dithyrambic poetry there is no one to whom he can address these dithyrambs except himself. Thus 14 is addressed to his own soul, 15 to the life he feels within him, 16 to himself in his future reincarnation. The eternity referred to in 16 is of course the eternal recurrence, and the child he wants to have by 'eternity' is – himself. PART FOUR. When, in January 1884, he closed his book with Seven Seals, Nietzsche thought Zarathustra was finished. But in the following winter he took up the theme again, and planned a further three parts. In the first of them, Zarathustra is visited by sundry 'higher men' who, as a consequence of Zarathustra's instruction, become conscious of their inadequacy. At the conclusion of this part Zarathustra receives the call to go out into the world again, and in the following part he accumulates a large following, to whom he preaches his now triumphant message. In the final part he dies, although Nietzsche could not decide in what manner. Of these three new parts only the first was written, slowly and with interruptions, in the winter of 1884–85. Nietzsche had it privately printed but withheld it from publication, and it first appeared, as 'the Fourth and Last Part' of Zarathustra in 1892, as part of the first collected edition of Nietzsche. Stylistically, Part Four is quite different from the earlier parts and on a lower level of inspiration. The 'higher men' are at once types and individuals. The gloomy prophet is Schopenhauer. The two kings are any kings. The conscientious man of the spirit is probably Darwin, although any scientific specialist would do. The sorcerer is Wagner (the sorcerer's poems are parodies of Wagner's later poetic manner). The last pope is of course (as yet) imaginary. The ugliest man and the shadow are representations of the atheist and the freethinker respectively. The voluntary beggar is either the Buddha or Tolstoy. The eternal recurrence remains in the background, but emerges at the conclusion, where it receives its most sonorous and ecstatic affirmation. June 1969 R.J.H. FURTHER READING David B. Allison, *Reading the New Nietzsche* (2001) MaudeMarie Clark, *Nietzsche on Truth and Morality* (1990) R.

J. Hollingdale, Nietzsche: The Man and His Philosophy (1965; 1999) Brian Leiter, Nietzsche on Morality (2002) Bernd Magnus and Kathleen Higgins (eds.), The Cambridge Companion to Nietzsche (1996) Alexander Nehamas, Nietzsche: Life as Literature (1985) F. Nietzsche, Daybreak: Thoughts on the Prejudices of Morality, trans. R. J. Hollingdale, introduction by M. Tanner (1982) ———, Dithyrambs of Dionysus, trans. with introduction and notes R. J. Hollingdale (1984; 2001) ———, Untimely Meditations, trans. R. J. Hollingdale, introduction by J. P. Stern (1983) John Richardson and Brian Leiter (eds.), Nietzsche (2001) Rudiger Safranski, Nietzsche: A Philosophical Biography, trans. Shelley Frisch (2002) Henry Staten, Nietzsche's Voice (1990) Tracy Strong, Friedrich Nietzsche and the Politics of Transfiguration (1988) PART ONE ZARATHUSTRA'S PROLOGUE 1 WHEN Zarathustra was thirty years old, he left his home and the lake of his home and went into the mountains. Here he had the enjoyment of his spirit and his solitude and he did not weary of it for ten years. But at last his heart turned – and one morning he rose with the dawn, stepped before the sun, and spoke to it thus: Great star! What would your happiness be, if you had not those for whom you shine! You have come up here to my cave for ten years: you would have grown weary of your light and of this journey, without me, my eagle and my serpent. But we waited for you every morning, took from you your superfluity and blessed you for it. Behold! I am weary of my wisdom, like a bee that has gathered too much honey; I need hands outstretched to take it. I should like to give it away and distribute it, until the wise among men have again become happy in their folly and the poor happy in their wealth. To that end, I must descend into the depths: as you do at evening, when you go behind the sea and bring light to the underworld too, superabundant star! Like you, I must go down 1 – as men, to whom I want to descend, call it. So bless me then, tranquil eye, that can behold without envy even an excessive happiness! Bless the cup that wants to overflow, that the waters may flow golden from him and bear the reflection of your joy over all the world! Behold! This cup wants to be empty again, and Zarathustra wants to be man again. Thus began Zarathustra's down-going. 2 Zarathustra went down the mountain alone, and no one met him. But when he entered the forest, an old man, who had left his holy hut to look for roots in the forest, suddenly stood before him. And the old man spoke thus to Zarathustra: 'This wanderer is no stranger to me: he passed by here many years ago. He was called Zarathustra; but he has changed. 'Then you carried your ashes to the mountains: will you today carry your fire into the valleys? Do you not fear an incendiary's punishment? 'Yes, I recognize Zarathustra. His eyes are clear, and no disgust lurks about his mouth. Does he not go along like a dancer? 'How changed Zarathustra is! Zarathustra has become – a child, an awakened-one: what do you want now with the sleepers? 'You lived in solitude as in the sea, and the sea bore you. Alas, do you want to go ashore? Alas,

do you want again to drag your body yourself?’ Zarathustra answered: ‘I love mankind.’ ‘Why’, said the saint, ‘did I go into the forest and the desert? Was it not because I loved mankind all too much? ‘Now I love God: mankind I do not love. Man is too imperfect a thing for me. Love of mankind would destroy me.’ Zarathustra answered: ‘What did I say of love? I am bringing mankind a gift.’ ‘Give them nothing,’ said the saint. ‘Rather take something off them and bear it with them – that will please them best; if only it be pleasing to you! ‘And if you want to give to them, give no more than an alms, and let them beg for that!’ ‘No,’ answered Zarathustra, ‘I give no alms. I am not poor enough for that.’ The saint laughed at Zarathustra, and spoke thus: ‘See to it that they accept your treasures! They are mistrustful of hermits, and do not believe that we come to give. ‘Our steps ring too lonely through their streets. And when at night they hear in their beds a man going by long before the sun has risen, they probably ask themselves: Where is that thief going? ‘Do not go to men, but stay in the forest! Go rather to the animals! Why will you not be as I am – a bear among bears, a bird among birds?’ ‘And what does the saint do in the forest?’ asked Zarathustra. The saint answered: ‘I make songs and sing them, and when I make songs, I laugh, weep, and mutter: thus I praise God. ‘With singing, weeping, laughing, and muttering I praise the God who is my God. But what do you bring us as a gift?’ When Zarathustra heard these words, he saluted the saint and said: ‘What should I have to give you! But let me go quickly, that I may take nothing from you!’ And thus they parted from one another, the old man and Zarathustra, laughing as two boys laugh. But when Zarathustra was alone, he spoke thus to his heart: ‘Could it be possible! This old saint has not yet heard in his forest that God is dead !’ 3 When Zarathustra arrived at the nearest of the towns lying against the forest, he found in that very place many people assembled in the market square: for it had been announced that a tight-rope walker would be appearing. And Zarathustra spoke thus to the people: I teach you the Superman . Man is something that should be overcome. What have you done to overcome him? All creatures hitherto have created something beyond themselves: and do you want to be the ebb of this great tide, and return to the animals rather than overcome man? What is the ape to men? A laughing-stock or a painful embarrassment. And just so shall man be to the Superman: a laughing-stock or a painful embarrassment. You have made your way from worm to man, and much in you is still worm. Once you were apes, and even now man is more of an ape than any ape. But he who is the wisest among you, he also is only a discord and hybrid of plant and of ghost. But do I bid you become ghosts or plants? Behold, I teach you the Superman. The Superman is the meaning of the earth. Let your will say: The Superman shall be the meaning of the earth! I entreat you, my brothers, remain true to the earth , and do not believe those who speak to you of superterrestrial hopes! They are poisoners, whether they know it or not. They are despisers of life, atrophying and

self-poisoned men, of whom the earth is weary: so let them be gone! Once blasphemy against God was the greatest blasphemy, but God died, and thereupon these blasphemers died too. To blaspheme the earth is now the most dreadful offence, and to esteem the bowels of the Inscrutable more highly than the meaning of the earth. Once the soul looked contemptuously upon the body: and then this contempt was the supreme good – the soul wanted the body lean, monstrous, famished. So the soul thought to escape from the body and from the earth. Oh, this soul was itself lean, monstrous, and famished: and cruelty was the delight of this soul! But tell me, my brothers: What does your body say about your soul? Is your soul not poverty and dirt and a miserable ease? In truth, man is a polluted river. One must be a sea, to receive a polluted river and not be defiled. Behold, I teach you the Superman: he is this sea, in him your great contempt can go under. What is the greatest thing you can experience? It is the hour of the great contempt. The hour in which even your happiness grows loathsome to you, and your reason and your virtue also. The hour when you say: ‘What good is my happiness? It is poverty and dirt and a miserable ease. But my happiness should justify existence itself!’ The hour when you say: ‘What good is my reason? Does it long for knowledge as the lion for its food? It is poverty and dirt and a miserable ease!’ The hour when you say: ‘What good is my virtue? It has not yet driven me mad! How tired I am of my good and my evil! It is all poverty and dirt and a miserable ease!’ The hour when you say: ‘What good is my justice? I do not see that I am fire and hot coals. But the just man is fire and hot coals!’ The hour when you say: ‘What good is my pity? Is not pity the cross upon which he who loves man is nailed? But my pity is no crucifixion!’ Have you ever spoken thus? Have you ever cried thus? Ah, that I had heard you crying thus! It is not your sin, but your moderation that cries to heaven, your very meanness in sinning cries to heaven! Where is the lightning to lick you with its tongue? Where is the madness, with which you should be cleansed? Behold, I teach you the Superman: he is this lightning, he is this madness! When Zarathustra had spoken thus, one of the people cried: ‘Now we have heard enough of the tight-rope walker; let us see him, too!’ And all the people laughed at Zarathustra. But the tight-rope walker, who thought that the words applied to him, set to work. 4 But Zarathustra looked at the people and marvelled. Then he spoke thus: Man is a rope, fastened between animal and Superman – a rope over an abyss. A dangerous going-across, a dangerous wayfaring, a dangerous looking-back, a dangerous shuddering and staying-still. What is great in man is that he is a bridge and not a goal; what can be loved in man is that he is a going-across and a down-going. 2 I love those who do not know how to live except their lives be a down-going, for they are those who are going across. I love the great despisers, for they are the great venerators and arrows of longing for the other bank. I love those who do not first seek beyond the stars for reasons to go down and to be sacrifices: but who sacrifice

themselves to the earth, that the earth may one day belong to the Superman. I love him who lives for knowledge and who wants knowledge that one day the Superman may live. And thus he wills his own downfall. I love him who works and invents that he may build a house for the Superman and prepare earth, animals, and plants for him: for thus he wills his own downfall. I love him who loves his virtue: for virtue is will to downfall and an arrow of longing. I love him who keeps back no drop of spirit for himself, but wants to be the spirit of his virtue entirely: thus he steps as spirit over the bridge. I love him who makes a predilection and a fate of his virtue: thus for his virtue's sake he will live or not live. I love him who does not want too many virtues. One virtue is more virtue than two, because it is more of a knot for fate to cling to. I love him whose soul is lavish, who neither wants nor returns thanks: for he always gives and will not preserve himself. I love him who is ashamed when the dice fall in his favour and who then asks: Am I then a cheat? – for he wants to perish. I love him who throws golden words in advance of his deeds and always performs more than he promised: for he wills his own downfall. I love him who justifies the men of the future and redeems the men of the past: for he wants to perish by the men of the present. I love him who chastises his God because he loves his God: for he must perish by the anger of his God. I love him whose soul is deep even in its ability to be wounded, and whom even a little thing can destroy: thus he is glad to go over the bridge. I love him whose soul is overfull, so that he forgets himself and all things are in him: thus all things become his downfall. I love him who is of a free spirit and a free heart: thus his head is only the bowels of his heart, but his heart drives him to his downfall. I love all those who are like heavy drops falling singly from the dark cloud that hangs over mankind: they prophesy the coming of the lightning and as prophets they perish. Behold, I am a prophet of the lightning and a heavy drop from the cloud: but this lightning is called Superman.

5 When Zarathustra had spoken these words he looked again at the people and fell silent. There they stand (he said to his heart), there they laugh: they do not understand me, I am not the mouth for these ears. Must one first shatter their ears to teach them to hear with their eyes? Must one rumble like drums and Lenten preachers? Or do they believe only those who stammer? They have something of which they are proud. What is it called that makes them proud? They call it culture, it distinguishes them from the goatherds. Therefore they dislike hearing the word 'contempt' spoken of them. So I shall speak to their pride. So I shall speak to them of the most contemptible man: and that is the Ultimate man. And thus spoke Zarathustra to the people: It is time for man to fix his goal. It is time for man to plant the seed of his highest hope. His soil is still rich enough for it. But this soil will one day be poor and weak; no longer will a high tree be able to grow from it. Alas! The time is coming when man will no more shoot the arrow of his longing out over mankind, and the string of his bow will have forgotten

how to twang! I tell you: one must have chaos in one, to give birth to a dancing star. I tell you: you still have chaos in you. Alas! The time is coming when man will give birth to no more stars. Alas! The time of the most contemptible man is coming, the man who can no longer despise himself. Behold! I shall show you the Ultimate Man, ‘What is love? What is creation? What is longing? What is a star?’ thus asks the Ultimate Man and blinks. The earth has become small, and upon it hops the Ultimate Man, who makes everything small. His race is as inextermin-able as the flea; the Ultimate Man lives longest. ‘We have discovered happiness,’ say the Ultimate Men and blink. They have left the places where living was hard: for one needs warmth. One still loves one’s neighbour and rubs oneself against him: for one needs warmth. Sickness and mistrust count as sins with them: one should go about warily. He is a fool who still stumbles over stones or over men! A little poison now and then: that produces pleasant dreams. And a lot of poison at last, for a pleasant death. They still work, for work is entertainment. But they take care the entertainment does not exhaust them. Nobody grows rich or poor any more: both are too much of a burden. Who still wants to rule? Who obey? Both are too much of a burden. No herdsman and one herd. Everyone wants the same thing, everyone is the same: whoever thinks otherwise goes voluntarily into the madhouse. ‘Formerly all the world was mad,’ say the most acute of them and blink. They are clever and know everything that has ever happened: so there is no end to their mockery. They still quarrel, but they soon make up – otherwise indigestion would result. They have their little pleasure for the day and their little pleasure for the night: but they respect health. ‘We have discovered happiness,’ say the Ultimate Men and blink. And here ended Zarathustra’s first discourse, which is also called ‘The Prologue’: 3 for at this point the shouting and mirth of the crowd interrupted him. ‘Give us this Ultimate Man, O Zarathustra’ – so they cried – ‘make us into this Ultimate Man! You can have the Superman!’ And all the people laughed and shouted. But Zarathustra grew sad and said to his heart: They do not understand me: I am not the mouth for these ears. Perhaps I lived too long in the mountains, listened too much to the trees and the streams: now I speak to them as to goatherds. Unmoved is my soul and bright as the mountains in the morning. But they think me cold and a mocker with fearful jokes. And now they look at me and laugh: and laughing, they still hate me. There is ice in their laughter. 6 But then something happened that silenced every mouth and fixed every eye. In the meantime, of course, the tight-rope walker had begun his work: he had emerged from a little door and was proceeding across the rope, which was stretched between two towers and thus hung over the people and the market square. Just as he had reached the middle of his course the little door opened again and a brightly-dressed fellow like a buffoon sprang out and followed the former with rapid steps. ‘Forward, lame-foot!’ cried his fearsome voice, ‘forward sluggish,

intruder, pallid-face! Lest I tickle you with my heels! What are you doing here between towers? You belong in the tower, you should be locked up, you are blocking the way of a better man than you!’ And with each word he came nearer and nearer to him: but when he was only a single pace behind him, there occurred the dreadful thing that silenced every mouth and fixed every eye: he emitted a cry like a devil and sprang over the man standing in his path. But the latter, when he saw his rival thus triumph, lost his head and the rope; he threw away his pole and fell, faster even than it, like a vortex of legs and arms. The market square and the people were like a sea in a storm: they flew apart in disorder, especially where the body would come crashing down. But Zarathustra remained still and the body fell quite close to him, badly injured and broken but not yet dead. After a while, consciousness returned to the shattered man and he saw Zarathustra kneeling beside him. ‘What are you doing?’ he asked at length. ‘I’ve known for a long time that the Devil would trip me up. Now he’s dragging me to Hell: are you trying to prevent him?’ ‘On my honour, friend,’ answered Zarathustra, ‘all you have spoken of does not exist: there is no Devil and no Hell. Your soul will be dead even before your body: therefore fear nothing any more!’ The man looked up mistrustfully. ‘If you are speaking the truth,’ he said then, ‘I leave nothing when I leave life. I am not much more than an animal which has been taught to dance by blows and starvation.’ ‘Not so,’ said Zarathustra. ‘You have made danger your calling, there is nothing in that to despise. Now you perish through your calling: so I will bury you with my own hands.’ When Zarathustra had said this the dying man replied no more; but he motioned with his hand, as if he sought Zarathustra’s hand to thank him. 7 In the meanwhile, evening had come and the market square was hidden in darkness: then the people dispersed, for even curiosity and terror grow tired. But Zarathustra sat on the ground beside the dead man and was sunk in thought: thus he forgot the time. But at length it became night and a cold wind blew over the solitary figure. Then Zarathustra arose and said to his heart: Truly, Zarathustra has had a handsome catch today! He caught no man, but he did catch a corpse. Uncanny is human existence and still without meaning: a buffoon can be fatal to it. I want to teach men the meaning of their existence: which is the Superman, the lightning from the dark cloud man. But I am still distant from them, and my meaning does not speak to their minds. To men, I am still a cross between a fool and a corpse. Dark is the night, dark are Zarathustra’s ways. Come, cold and stiff companion! I am going to carry you to the place where I shall bury you with my own hands. 8 When Zarathustra had said this to his heart he loaded the corpse on to his back and set forth. He had not gone a hundred paces when a man crept up to him and whispered in his ear – and behold! it was the buffoon of the tower who spoke to him. ‘Go away from this town, O Zarathustra,’ he said. ‘Too many here hate you. The good and the just hate you and call you their enemy and despiser; the faithful

of the true faith hate you, and they call you a danger to the people. It was lucky for you that they laughed at you: and truly you spoke like a buffoon. It was lucky for you that you made company with the dead dog; by so abasing yourself you have saved yourself for today. But leave this town – or tomorrow I shall jump over you, a living man over a dead one.’ And when he had said this, the man disappeared; Zarathustra, however, went on through the dark streets. At the town gate the gravediggers accosted him: they shone their torch in his face, recognized Zarathustra and greatly derided him. ‘Zarathustra is carrying the dead dog away: excellent that Zarathustra has become a gravedigger! For our hands are too clean for this roast. Does Zarathustra want to rob the Devil of his morsel? Good luck then! A hearty appetite! But if the Devil is a better thief than Zarathustra! – he will steal them both, he will eat them both!’ And they laughed and put their heads together. Zarathustra said nothing and went his way. When he had walked for two hours past woods and swamps he had heard too much hungry howling of wolves and he grew hungry himself. So he stopped at a lonely house in which a light was burning. ‘Hunger has waylaid me’, said Zarathustra, ‘like a robber. My hunger has waylaid me in woods and swamps, and in the depth of night. ‘My hunger has astonishing moods. Often it comes to me only after mealtimes, and today it did not come at all: where has it been?’ And with that, Zarathustra knocked on the door of the house. An old man appeared; he carried a light and asked: ‘Who comes here to me and to my uneasy sleep?’ ‘A living man and a dead,’ said Zarathustra. ‘Give me food and drink, I forgot about them during the day. He who feeds the hungry refreshes his own soul: thus speaks wisdom.’ The old man went away, but returned at once and offered Zarathustra bread and wine. ‘This is a bad country for hungry people,’ he said. ‘That is why I live here. Animals and men come here to me, the hermit. But bid your companion eat and drink, he is wearier than you.’ Zarathustra answered: ‘My companion is dead, I shall hardly be able to persuade him.’ ‘‘That is nothing to do with me,’ said the old man morosely. ‘Whoever knocks at my door must take what I offer him. Eat, and fare you well!’ After that, Zarathustra walked two hours more and trusted to the road and to the light of the stars: for he was used to walking abroad at night and liked to look into the face of all that slept. But when morning dawned, Zarathustra found himself in a thick forest and the road disappeared. Then he laid the dead man in a hollow tree at his head – for he wanted to protect him from the wolves – and laid himself down on the mossy ground. And straightway he fell asleep, weary in body but with a soul at rest. 9 Zarathustra slept long, and not only the dawn but the morning too passed over his head. But at length he opened his eyes: in surprise Zarathustra gazed into the forest and the stillness, in surprise he gazed into himself. Then he arose quickly, like a seafarer who suddenly sees land, and rejoiced: for he beheld a new truth. And then he spoke to his heart thus: A light has dawned for me: I need companions, living ones, not dead companions

and corpses which I carry with me wherever I wish. But I need living companions who follow me because they want to follow themselves – and who want to go where I want to go. A light has dawned for me: Zarathustra shall not speak to the people but to companions! Zarathustra shall not be herdsman and dog to the herd! To lure many away from the herd – that is why I have come. The people and the herd shall be angry with me: the herdsmen shall call Zarathustra a robber. I say herdsmen, but they call themselves the good and the just. I say herdsmen: but they call themselves the faithful of the true faith. Behold the good and the just! Whom do they hate most? Him who smashes their tables of values, the breaker, the lawbreaker 4 – but he is the creator. Behold the faithful of all faiths! Whom do they hate the most? Him who smashes their tables of values, the breaker, the law-breaker – but he is the creator. The creator seeks companions, not corpses or herds or believers. The creator seeks fellow-creators, those who inscribe new values on new tables. The creator seeks companions and fellow-harvesters: for with him everything is ripe for harvesting. But he lacks his hundred sickles: so he tears off the ears of corn and is vexed. The creator seeks companions and such as know how to whet their sickles. They will be called destroyers and despisers of good and evil. But they are harvesters and rejoicers. Zarathustra seeks fellow-creators, fellow-harvesters, and fellow-rejoicers: what has he to do with herds and herdsmen and corpses! And you, my first companion, fare you well! I have buried you well in your hollow tree, I have hidden you well from the wolves. But I am leaving you, the time has come. Between dawn and dawn a new truth has come to me. I will not be herdsman or gravedigger. I will not speak again to the people: I have spoken to a dead man for the last time. I will make company with creators, with harvesters, with rejoicers: I will show them the rainbow and the stairway to the Superman. I shall sing my song to the lone hermit and to the hermits in pairs; and I will make the heart of him who still has ears for unheard-of things heavy with my happiness. I make for my goal, I go my way; I shall leap over the hesitating and the indolent. Thus may my going-forward be their going-down! 10 Zarathustra said this to his heart as the sun stood at noon: then he looked inquiringly into the sky – for he heard above him the sharp cry of a bird. And behold! An eagle was sweeping through the air in wide circles, and from it was hanging a serpent, not like a prey but like a friend: for it was coiled around the eagle's neck. 'It is my animals!' said Zarathustra and rejoiced in his heart. 'The proudest animal under the sun and the wisest animal under the sun' they have come scouting. 'They wanted to learn if Zarathustra was still alive. Am I in fact alive? 'I found it more dangerous among men than among animals; Zarathustra is following dangerous paths. May my animals lead me!' When Zarathustra had said this he recalled the words of the saint in the forest, sighed, and spoke thus to his heart: 'I wish I were wise! I wish I were wise from the heart of me, like my serpent! 'But I am asking the impossible: therefore I ask

my pride always to go along with my wisdom! ‘And if one day my wisdom should desert me – ah, it loves to fly away! – then may my pride too fly with my folly!’ Thus began Zarathustra’s down-going. ZARATHUSTRA’S DISCOURSES Of the Three Metamorphoses I NAME you three metamorphoses of the spirit: how the spirit shall become a camel, and the camel a lion, and the lion at last a child. There are many heavy things for the spirit, for the strong, weight-bearing spirit in which dwell respect and awe: its strength longs for the heavy, for the heaviest. What is heavy? thus asks the weight-bearing spirit, thus it kneels down like the camel and wants to be well laden. What is the heaviest thing, you heroes? so asks the weight-bearing spirit, that I may take it upon me and rejoice in my strength. Is it not this: to debase yourself in order to injure your pride? To let your folly shine out in order to mock your wisdom? Or is it this: to desert our cause when it is celebrating its victory? To climb high mountains in order to tempt the tempter? Or is it this: to feed upon the acorns and grass of knowledge and for the sake of truth to suffer hunger of the soul? Or is it this: to be sick and to send away comforters and make friends with the deaf, who never hear what you ask? Or is it this: to wade into dirty water when it is the water of truth, and not to disdain cold frogs and hot toads? Or is it this: to love those who despise us and to offer our hand to the ghost when it wants to frighten us? The weight-bearing spirit takes upon itself all these heaviest things: like a camel hurrying laden into the desert, thus it hurries into its desert. But in the loneliest desert the second metamorphosis occurs: the spirit here becomes a lion; it wants to capture freedom and be lord in its own desert. It seeks here its ultimate lord: it will be an enemy to him and to its ultimate God, it will struggle for victory with the great dragon. What is the great dragon which the spirit no longer wants to call lord and God? The great dragon is called ‘Thou shalt’. But the spirit of the lion says ‘I will!’ ‘Thou shalt’ lies in its path, sparkling with gold, a scale-covered beast, and on every scale glitters golden ‘Thou shalt’. Values of a thousand years glitter on the scales, and thus speaks the mightiest of all dragons: ‘All the values of things – glitter on me. ‘All values have already been created, and all created values – are in me. Truly, there shall be no more “I will”!’ Thus speaks the dragon. My brothers, why is the lion needed in the spirit? Why does the beast of burden, that renounces and is reverent, not suffice? To create new values – even the lion is incapable of that: but to create itself freedom for new creation – that the might of the lion can do. To create freedom for itself and a sacred No even to duty: the lion is needed for that, my brothers. To seize the right to new values – that is the most terrible proceeding for a weight-bearing and reverential spirit Truly, to this spirit it is a theft and a work for an animal of prey. Once it loved this ‘Thou shalt’ as its holiest thing: now it has to find illusion and caprice even in the holiest, that it may steal freedom from its love: the lion is needed for this theft. But tell me, my brothers, what can the child do that even the lion cannot?

Why must the preying lion still become a child? The child is innocence and forgetfulness, a new beginning, a sport, a self-propelling wheel, a first motion, a sacred Yes. Yes, a sacred Yes is needed, my brothers, for the sport of creation: the spirit now wills its own will, the spirit sundered from the world now wins its own world. I have named you three metamorphoses of the spirit: how the spirit became a camel, and the camel a lion, and the lion at last a child. Thus spoke Zarathustra. And at that time he was living in the town called The Pied Cow. Of the Chairs of Virtue Z ARATHUSTRA heard a wise man praised who was said to discourse well on sleep and virtue: he was greatly honoured and rewarded for it, and all the young men sat before his chair. Zarathustra went to him and sat before his chair with all the young men. And thus spoke the wise man: Honour to sleep and modesty before it! That is the first thing! And avoid all those who sleep badly and are awake at night! Even the thief is shamed when confronted with sleep: he always steals softly through the night. But shameless is the night-watchman, shamelessly he bears his horn. Sleeping is no mean art: you need to stay awake all day to do it. You must overcome yourself ten times a day: that causes a fine weariness and is opium to the soul. Ten times must you be reconciled to yourself again: for overcoming is bitterness and the unreconciled man sleeps badly. You must discover ten truths a day: otherwise you will seek truth in the night too, with your soul still hungry. You must laugh and be cheerful ten times a day: or your stomach, that father of affliction, will disturb you in the night. Few know it, but one must have all the virtues in order to sleep well. Shall I bear false witness? Shall I commit adultery? Shall I covet my neighbour's maidservant? None of this would be consistent with good sleep. And even when one has all the virtues, there is still one thing to remember: to send even these virtues to sleep at the proper time. That they may not quarrel among themselves, the pretty little women! And over you, unhappy man! Peace with God and with your neighbour: thus good sleep will have it. And peace too with your neighbour's devil. Otherwise he will haunt you at night. Honour and obedience to the authorities, and even to the crooked authorities! Thus good sleep will have it. How can I help it that power likes to walk on crooked legs? I shall always call him the best herdsman who leads his sheep to the greenest meadows: that accords with good sleep. I do not desire much honour, nor great treasure: they excite spleen. But one sleeps badly without a good name and a small treasure. The company of a few is more welcome to me than bad company: but they must come and go at the proper time. That accords with good sleep. The poor in spirit, too, please me greatly: they further sleep. Blessed and happy they are indeed, especially if one always agrees with their views. Thus for the virtuous man does the day pass. And when night comes I take good care not to summon sleep! He, the lord of virtues, does not like to be summoned! But I remember what I have done and thought during the day. Ruminating I ask myself, patient as a cow:

What were your ten overcomings? And which were the ten reconciliations and the ten truths and the ten fits of laughter with which my heart enjoyed itself? As I ponder such things rocked by my forty thoughts, sleep, the lord of virtue, suddenly overtakes me uncalled. Sleep knocks on my eyes: they grow heavy. Sleep touches my mouth: it stays open. Truly, he comes to me on soft soles, the dearest of thieves, and steals my thoughts from me: I stand as silent as this chair. But I do not stand for long: already I am lying down. When Zarathustra heard the wise man's words he laughed in his heart: for through them a light had dawned upon him. And he spoke thus to his heart: This wise man with his forty thoughts seems to me a fool: but I believe he knows well enough how to sleep. Happy is he who lives in this wise man's neighbourhood. Such sleep is contagious, even through a thick wall. A spell dwells even in his chair. And the young men have not sat in vain before the preacher of virtue. His wisdom is: stay awake in order to sleep well. And truly, if life had no sense and I had to choose nonsense, this would be the most desirable nonsense for me, too. Now it is clear to me what people were once seeking above all when they sought the teachers of virtue. They sought good sleep and opium virtues to bring it about! To all of these lauded wise men of the academic chairs, wisdom meant sleep without dreams: they knew no better meaning of life. And today too there are some like this preacher of virtue, and not always so honourable: but their time is up. And they shall not stand for much longer: already they are lying down. Blessed are these drowsy men: for they shall soon drop off. Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Afterworldsmen O NCE Zarathustra too cast his deluded fancy beyond mankind, like all afterworldsmen. 5 Then the world seemed to me the work of a suffering and tormented God. Then the world seemed to me the dream and fiction of a God; coloured vapour before the eyes of a discontented God. Good and evil and joy and sorrow and I and You – I thought them coloured vapour before the creator's eyes. The creator wanted to look away from himself, so he created the world. It is intoxicating joy for the sufferer to look away from his suffering and to forget himself. Intoxicating joy and self-forgetting – that is what I once thought the world. This world, the eternally imperfect, the eternal and imperfect image of a contradiction – an intoxicating joy to its imperfect creator – that is what I once thought the world. Thus I too once cast my deluded fancy beyond mankind, like all afterworldsmen. Beyond mankind in reality? Ah, brothers, this God which I created was human work and human madness, like all gods! He was human, and only a poor piece of man and Ego: this phantom came to me from my own fire and ashes, that is the truth! It did not come to me from the 'beyond'! What happened, my brothers? I, the sufferer, overcame myself, I carried my own ashes to the mountains, I made for myself a brighter flame. And behold! the phantom fled from me! Now to me, the convalescent, it would be suffering and torment to believe in such phantoms: it would be suffering to me now and

humiliation. Thus I speak to the afterworldsmen. It was suffering and impotence – that created all afterworlds; and that brief madness of happiness that only the greatest sufferer experiences. Weariness, which wants to reach the ultimate with a single leap, with a death-leap, 6 a poor ignorant weariness, which no longer wants even to want: that created all gods and afterworlds. Believe me, my brothers! It was the body that despaired of the body – that touched the ultimate walls with the fingers of its deluded spirit. Believe me, my brothers! It was the body that despaired of the earth – that heard the belly of being speak to it. And then it wanted to get its head through the ultimate walls – and not its head only 7 – over into the ‘other world’. But that ‘other world’, that inhuman, dehumanized world which is a heavenly Nothing, is well hidden from men; and the belly of being does not speak to man, except as man. Truly, all being is hard to demonstrate; it is hard to make it speak. Yet, tell me, brothers, is not the most wonderful of all things most clearly demonstrated? Yes, this Ego, with its contradiction and confusion, speaks most honestly of its being – this creating, willing, evaluating Ego, which is the measure and value of things. And this most honest being, the Ego – it speaks of the body, and it insists upon the body, even when it fables and fabricates and flutters with broken wings. Ever more honestly it learns to speak, the Ego: and the more it learns, the more it finds titles and honours for the body and the earth. My Ego taught me a new pride, I teach it to men: No longer to bury the head in the sand of heavenly things, but to carry it freely, an earthly head which creates meaning for the earth. I teach mankind a new will: to desire this path that men have followed blindly, and to call it good and no more to creep aside from it, like the sick and dying! It was the sick and dying who despised the body and the earth and invented the things of heaven and the redeeming drops of blood: but even these sweet and dismal poisons they took from the body and the earth! They wanted to escape from their misery and the stars were too far for them. Then they sighed: ‘Oh if only there were heavenly paths by which to creep into another existence and into happiness!’ – then they contrived for themselves their secret ways and their draughts of blood! Now they thought themselves transported from their bodies and from this earth, these ingrates. Yet to what do they owe the convulsion and joy of their transport? To their bodies and to this earth. Zarathustra is gentle with the sick. Truly, he is not angry at their manner of consolation and ingratitude. May they become convalescents and overcomers and make for themselves a higher body! Neither is Zarathustra angry with the convalescent if he glances tenderly at his illusions and creeps at midnight around the grave of his God: but even his tears still speak to me of sickness and a sick body. There have always been many sickly people among those who invent fables and long for God: they have a raging hate for the enlightened man and for that youngest of virtues which is called honesty. They are always looking back to dark ages: then, indeed, illusion and faith were a

different question; raving of the reason was likeness to God, and doubt was sin. I know these Godlike people all too well: they want to be believed in, and doubt to be sin. I also know all too well what it is they themselves most firmly believe in. Truly not in afterworlds and redeeming drops of blood: they believe most firmly in the body, and their own body is for them their thing-in-itself. But it is a sickly thing to them: and they would dearly like to get out of their skins. That is why they hearken to preachers of death and themselves preach afterworlds. Listen rather, my brothers, to the voice of the healthy body: this is a purer voice and a more honest one. Purer and more honest of speech is the healthy body, perfect and square-built: and it speaks of the meaning of the earth. Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Despisers of the Body I WISH to speak to the despisers of the body. Let them not learn differently nor teach differently, but only bid farewell to their own bodies – and so become dumb. ‘I am body and soul’ – so speaks the child. And why should one not speak like children? But the awakened, the enlightened man says: I am body entirely, and nothing beside; and soul is only a word for something in the body. The body is a great intelligence, a multiplicity with one sense, a war and a peace, a herd and a herdsman. Your little intelligence, my brother, which you call ‘spirit’, is also an instrument of your body, a little instrument and toy of your great intelligence. You say ‘I’ and you are proud of this word. But greater than this – although you will not believe in it – is your body and its great intelligence, which does not say ‘I’ but performs ‘I’. What the sense feels, what the spirit perceives, is never an end in itself. But sense and spirit would like to persuade you that they are the end of all things: they are as vain as that. Sense and spirit are instruments and toys: behind them still lies the Self. The Self seeks with the eyes of the sense, it listens too with the ears of the spirit. The Self is always listening and seeking: it compares, subdues, conquers, destroys. It rules and is also the Ego’s ruler. Behind your thoughts and feelings, my brother, stands a mighty commander, an unknown sage – he is called Self. He lives in your body, he is your body. There is more reason in your body than in your best wisdom. And who knows for what purpose your body requires precisely your best wisdom? Your Self laughs at your Ego and its proud leapings. ‘What are these leapings and flights of thought to me?’ it says to itself. ‘A by-way to my goal. I am the Ego’s leading-string and I prompt its conceptions.’ The Self says to the Ego: ‘Feel pain!’ Thereupon it suffers and gives thought how to end its suffering – and it is meant to think for just that purpose. The Self says to the Ego: ‘Feel joy!’ Thereupon it rejoices and gives thought how it may often rejoice – and it is meant to think for just that purpose. I want to say a word to the despisers of the body. It is their esteem that produces this disesteem. What is it that created esteem and disesteem and value and will? The creative Self created for itself esteem and disesteem, it created for itself joy and sorrow. The creative body created spirit for itself, as a hand of its will. Even

in your folly and contempt, you despisers of the body, you serve your Self. I tell you: your Self itself wants to die and turn away from life. Your Self can no longer perform that act which it most desires to perform: to create beyond itself. That is what it most wishes to do, that is its whole ardour. But now it has grown too late for that: so your Self wants to perish, you despisers of the body. Your Self wants to perish, and that is why you have become despisers of the body! For no longer are you able to create beyond yourselves. And therefore you are now angry with life and with the earth. An unconscious envy lies in the sidelong glance of your contempt. I do not go your way, you despisers of the body! You are not bridges to the Superman! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of Joys and Passions

M Y brother, if you have a virtue and it is your own virtue, you have it in common with no one. To be sure, you want to call it by a name and caress it; you want to pull its ears and amuse yourself with it. And behold! Now you have its name in common with the people and have become of the people and the herd with your virtue! You would do better to say: 'Unutterable and nameless is that which torments and delights my soul and is also the hunger of my belly.' Let your virtue be too exalted for the familiarity of names: and if you have to speak of it, do not be ashamed to stammer. Thus say and stammer: 'This is my good, this I love, just thus do I like it, only thus do I wish the good. 'I do not want it as a law of God, I do not want it as a human statute: let it be no sign-post to superearths and paradises. 'It is an earthly virtue that I love: there is little prudence in it, and least of all common wisdom. 'But this bird has built its nest beneath my roof: therefore I love and cherish it – now it sits there upon its golden eggs.' Thus should you stammer and praise your virtue. Once you had passions and called them evil. But now you have only your virtues: they grew from out your passions. You laid your highest aim in the heart of these passions: then they became your virtues and joys. And though you came from the race of the hot-tempered or of the lustful or of the fanatical or of the vindictive: At last all your passions have become virtues and all your devils angels. Once you had fierce dogs in your cellar: but they changed at last into birds and sweet singers. From your poison you brewed your balsam; you milked your cow, affliction, now you drink the sweet milk of her udder. And henceforward nothing evil shall come out of you, except it be the evil that comes from the conflict of your virtues. My brother, if you are lucky you will have one virtue and no more: thus you will go more easily over the bridge. To have many virtues is to be distinguished, but it is a hard fate; and many a man has gone into the desert and killed himself because he was tired of being a battle and battleground of virtues. My brother, are war and battle evil? But this evil is necessary, envy and mistrust and calumny among your virtues is necessary. Behold how each of your virtues desires the highest place: it wants your entire spirit, that your spirit may be its herald, it wants your entire strength in anger, hate, and love. Every virtue is jealous of the others, and

jealousy is a terrible thing. Even virtues can be destroyed through jealousy. He whom the flames of jealousy surround at last turns his poisoned sting against himself, like the scorpion. Ah my brother, have you never yet seen a virtue turn upon itself and stab itself? Man is something that must be overcome: and for that reason you must love your virtues – for you will perish by them. Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Pale Criminal Y OU do not intend to kill, you judges and sacrificers, before the beast has bowed its neck? Behold, the pale criminal has bowed his neck: from his eye speaks the great contempt. ‘My Ego is something that should be overcome: my Ego is to me the great contempt of man’: that is what this eye says. He judged himself – that was his supreme moment: do not let the exalted man relapse again into his lowly condition! There is no redemption for him who thus suffers from himself, except it be a quick death. Your killing, you judges, should be a mercy and not a revenge. And since you kill, see to it that you yourselves justify life! It is not sufficient that you should be reconciled with him you kill. May your sorrow be love for the Superman: thus will you justify your continuing to live! You should say ‘enemy’, but not ‘miscreant’; you should say ‘invalid’, but not ‘scoundrel’; you should say ‘fool’, but not ‘sinner’. And you, scarlet judge, if you would speak aloud all you have done in thought, everyone would cry: ‘Away with this filth and poisonous snake!’ But the thought is one thing, the deed is another, and another yet is the image of the deed. The wheel of causality does not roll between them. An image made this pale man pale. He was equal to his deed when he did it: but he could not endure its image after it was done. Now for evermore he saw himself as the perpetrator of one deed. I call this madness: in him the exception has become the rule. The chalk-line charmed the hen; the blow he struck charmed his simple mind – I call this madness after the deed. Listen, you judges! There is another madness as well; and it comes before the deed. Ah, you have not crept deep enough into this soul! Thus says the scarlet judge: ‘Why did this criminal murder? He wanted to steal.’ But I tell you: his soul wanted blood not booty; he thirsted for the joy of the knife! But his simple mind did not understand this madness and it persuaded him otherwise. ‘What is the good of blood?’ it said. ‘Will you not at least commit a theft too? Take a revenge?’ And he hearkened to his simple mind: its words lay like lead upon him – then he robbed as he murdered. He did not want to be ashamed of his madness. And now again the lead of his guilt lies upon him, and again his simple mind is so numb, so paralysed, so heavy. If only he could shake his head his burden would roll off: but who can shake this head? What is this man? A heap of diseases that reach out into the world through the spirit: there they want to catch their prey. What is this man? A knot of savage serpents that are seldom at peace among themselves – thus they go forth alone to seek prey in the world. Behold this poor body! This poor soul interpreted to itself what this body suffered and desired – it interpreted it as lust for murder and greed for the

joy of the knife. The evil which is now evil overtakes him who now becomes sick: he wants to do harm with that which harms him. But there have been other ages and another evil and good. Once doubt and the will to Self were evil. Then the invalid became heretic and witch: as heretic and witch he suffered and wanted to cause suffering. But this will not enter your ears: you tell me it hurts your good people. But what are your good people to me? Much about your good people moves me to disgust, and it is not their evil I mean. How I wish they possessed a madness through which they could perish, like this pale criminal. Truly, I wish their madness were called truth or loyalty or justice: but they possess their virtue in order to live long and in a miserable ease. I am a railing beside the stream: he who can grasp me, let him grasp me! I am not, however, your crutch. Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of Reading and Writing O F all writings I love only that which is written with blood. Write with blood: and you will discover that blood is spirit. It is not an easy thing to understand unfamiliar blood: I hate the reading idler. He who knows the reader, does nothing further for the reader. Another century of readers – and spirit itself will stink. That everyone can learn to read will ruin in the long run not only writing, but thinking too. Once spirit was God, then it became man, and now it is even becoming mob. He who writes in blood and aphorisms does not want to be read, he wants to be learned by heart. In the mountains the shortest route is from peak to peak, but for that you must have long legs. Aphorisms should be peaks, and those to whom they are spoken should be big and tall of stature. The air thin and pure, danger near, and the spirit full of a joyful wickedness: these things suit one another. I want hobgoblins around me, for I am courageous. Courage that scares away phantoms makes hobgoblins for itself – courage wants to laugh. I no longer feel as you do: this cloud which I see under me, this blackness and heaviness at which I laugh – precisely this is your thunder-cloud. You look up when you desire to be exalted. And I look down, because I am exalted. Who among you can at the same time laugh and be exalted? He who climbs upon the highest mountains laughs at all tragedies, real or imaginary. Untroubled, scornful, outrageous – that is how wisdom wants us to be: she is a woman and never loves anyone but a warrior. You tell me: ‘Life is hard to bear.’ But if it were otherwise why should you have your pride in the morning and your resignation in the evening? Life is hard to bear: but do not pretend to be so tender! We are all of us pretty fine asses and assesses of burden! What have we in common with the rosebud, which trembles because a drop of dew is lying upon it? It is true: we love life, not because we are used to living but because we are used to loving. There is always a certain madness in love. But also there is always a certain method in madness. And to me too, who love life, it seems that butterflies and soap-bubbles, and whatever is like them among men, know most about happiness. To see these light, foolish, dainty, affecting little souls flutter about – that moves Zarathustra to tears and to

song. I should believe only in a God who understood how to dance. And when I beheld my devil, I found him serious, thorough, profound, solemn: it was the Spirit of Gravity – through him all things are ruined. One does not kill by anger but by laughter. Come, let us kill the Spirit of Gravity! I have learned to walk: since then I have run. I have learned to fly: since then I do not have to be pushed in order to move. Now I am nimble, now I fly, now I see myself under myself, now a god dances within me. Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Tree on the Mountainside Z ARATHUSTRA had noticed that a young man was avoiding him. And as he was walking alone one evening through the mountains surrounding the town called The Pied Cow, behold! he found this young man leaning against a tree and gazing wearily into the valley. Zarathustra grasped the tree beside which the young man was sitting and spoke thus: ‘If I wanted to shake this tree with my hands I should be unable to do it. ‘But the wind, which we cannot see, torments it and bends it where it wishes. It is invisible hands that torment and bend us the worst.’ At that the young man stood up in confusion and said: ‘I hear Zarathustra and I was just thinking of him.’ Zarathustra replied: ‘Why are you alarmed on that account? – Now it is with men as with this tree. ‘The more it wants to rise into the heights and the light, the more determinedly do its roots strive earthwards, downwards, into the darkness, into the depths – into evil.’ ‘Yes, into evil!’ cried the young man. ‘How is it possible you can uncover my soul?’ Zarathustra smiled and said: ‘There are many souls one will never uncover, unless one invents them first.’ ‘Yes, into evil!’ cried the young man again. ‘You have spoken the truth, Zarathustra. Since I wanted to rise into the heights I have no longer trusted myself, and no one trusts me any more. How did this happen? ‘I change too quickly: my today refutes my yesterday. When I ascend I often jump over steps, and no step forgives me that. ‘When I am aloft, I always find myself alone. No one speaks to me, the frost of solitude makes me tremble. What do I want in the heights? ‘My contempt and my desire increase together; the higher I climb, the more do I despise him who climbs. What do I want in the heights? ‘How ashamed I am of my climbing and stumbling! How I scorn my violent panting! How I hate the man who can fly! How weary I am in the heights!’ Here the young man fell silent. And Zarathustra contemplated the tree beside which they were standing, and spoke thus: ‘This tree stands here alone on the mountainside; it has grown up high above man and animal. ‘And if it wished to speak, it would find no one who understood it: so high has it grown. ‘Now it waits and waits – yet what is it waiting for? It lives too near the seat of the clouds: is it waiting, perhaps, for the first lightning?’ When Zarathustra said this, the young man cried with violent gestures: ‘Yes, Zarathustra, you speak true. I desired my destruction when I wanted to ascend into the heights, and you are the lightning for which I have been waiting! Behold, what have I been since you appeared among us? It is envy of you which has destroyed me!’ Thus spoke

the young man and wept bitterly. But Zarathustra hid his arm about him and drew him along with him. And when they had been walking together for a while, Zarathustra began to speak thus: It breaks my heart. Better than your words, your eye tells me all your peril. You are not yet free, you still search for freedom. Your search has fatigued you and made you too wakeful. You long for the open heights, your soul thirsts for the stars. But your bad instincts too thirst for freedom. Your fierce dogs long for freedom; they bark for joy in their cellar when your spirit aspires to break open all prisons. To me you are still a prisoner who imagines freedom: ah, such prisoners of the soul become clever, but also deceitful and base. The free man of the spirit, too, must still purify himself. Much of the prison and rottenness still remain within him: his eye still has to become pure. Yes, I know your peril. But, by my love and hope I entreat you: do not reject your love and hope! You still feel yourself noble, and the others, too, who dislike you and cast evil glances at you, still feel you are noble. Learn that everyone finds the noble man an obstruction. The good, too, find the noble man an obstruction: and even when they call him a good man they do so in order to make away with him. The noble man wants to create new things and a new virtue. The good man wants the old things and that the old things shall be preserved. But that is not the danger for the noble man – that he may become a good man – but that he may become an impudent one, a derider, a destroyer. Alas, I have known noble men who lost their highest hope. And henceforth they slandered all high hopes. Henceforth they lived impudently in brief pleasures, and they had hardly an aim beyond the day. ‘Spirit is also sensual pleasure’ – thus they spoke. Then the wings of their spirit broke: now it creeps around and it makes dirty what it feeds on. Once they thought of becoming heroes: now they are sensualists. The hero is to them an affliction and a terror. But, by my love and hope I entreat you: do not reject the hero in your soul! Keep holy your highest hope! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Preachers of Death T HERE are preachers of death: and the earth is full of those to whom departure from life must be preached. The earth is full of the superfluous, life has been corrupted by the many-too-many. Let them be lured by ‘eternal life’ out of this life! Yellow men or black men: that is what the preachers of death are called. But I want to show them to you in other colours. There are the dreadful creatures who carry a beast of prey around within them, and have no choice except lusts or self-mortification. And even their lusts are self-mortification. They have not yet even become men, these dreadful creatures. Let them preach departure from life and depart themselves! There are the consumptives of the soul: they are hardly born before they begin to die and to long for doctrines of weariness and renunciation. They would like to be dead, and we should approve their wish! Let us guard against awakening these dead men and damaging these living coffins. They encounter an invalid or an old man or a corpse; and straightway they say ‘Life is

refuted!’ But only they are refuted, they and their eye that sees only one aspect of existence. Muffled in deep depression, and longing for the little accidents that bring about death: thus they wait and clench their teeth. Or: they snatch at sweets and in doing so mock their childishness: they cling to their straw of life and mock that they are still clinging to a straw. Their wisdom runs: ‘He who goes on living is a fool, but we are such fools! And precisely that is the most foolish thing in life!’ ‘Life is only suffering’ – thus others of them speak, and they do not lie: so see to it that you ’ cease to live! So see to it that the life which is only suffering ceases! And let the teaching of your virtue be: ‘You shall kill yourself! You shall steal away from yourself!’ ‘Lust is sin’ – thus say some who preach death – ‘let us go aside and beget no children!’ ‘Giving birth is laborious’ – say others – ‘why go on giving birth? One gives birth only to unhappy children!’ And they too are preachers of death. ‘Men are to be pitied’ – thus say others again. ‘Take what I have! Take what I am! By so much less am I bound to life!’ If they were compassionate from the very heart they would seek to make their neighbours disgusted with life. To be evil -that would be their true good. But they want to escape from life: what is it to them that, with their chains and gifts, they bind others still more firmly to it? And you too, you to whom life is unrestrained labour and anxiety: are you not very weary of life? Are you not very ripe for the sermon of death? All of you, to whom unrestrained labour, and the swift, the new, the strange, are dear, you endure yourselves ill, your industry is flight and will to forget yourselves. If you believed more in life, you would devote yourselves less to the moment. But you have insufficient capacity for waiting – or even for laziness! Everywhere resound the voices of those who preach death: and the earth is full of those to whom death must be preached. Or ‘eternal life’: it is all the same to me – provided they pass away quickly! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of War and Warriors W E do not wish to be spared by our best enemies, nor by those whom we love from the very heart. So let me tell you the truth! My brothers in war! I love you from the very heart, I am and have always been of your kind. And I am also your best enemy. So let me tell you the truth! I know the hatred and envy of your hearts. You are not great enough not to know hatred and envy. So be great enough not to be ashamed of them! And if you cannot be saints of knowledge, at least be its warriors. They are the companions and forerunners of such sainthood. I see many soldiers: if only I could see many warriors! What they wear is called uniform: may what they conceal with it not be uniform too! You should be such men as are always looking for an enemy – for your enemy. And with some of you there is hate at first sight. You should seek your enemy, you should wage your war – a war for your opinions. And if your opinion is defeated, your honesty should still cry triumph over that! You should love peace as a means to new wars. And the short peace more than the long. I do not exhort you to work but to battle. I do not exhort you to peace, but to victory.

May your work be a battle, may your peace be a victory! One can be silent and sit still only when one has arrow and bow: otherwise one babbles and quarrels. May your peace be a victory! You say it is the good cause that hallows even war? I tell you: it is the good war that hallows every cause. War and courage have done more great things than charity. Not your pity but your bravery has saved the unfortunate up to now. ‘What is good?’ you ask. To be brave is good. Let the little girls say: ‘To be good is to be what is pretty and at the same time touching.’ They call you heartless: but your heart is true, and I love the modesty of your kind-heartedness. You feel ashamed of your flow, while others feel ashamed of their ebb. Are you ugly? Very well, my brothers! Take the sublime about you, the mantle of the ugly! And when your soul grows great, it grows arrogant, and there is wickedness in your sublimity. I know you. In wickedness, the arrogant and the weak man meet. But they misunderstand one another. I know you. You may have enemies whom you hate, but not enemies whom you despise. You must be proud of your enemy: then the success of your enemy shall be your success too. To rebel – that shows nobility in a slave. Let your nobility show itself in obeying! Let even your commanding be an obeying! To a good warrior, ‘thou shalt’ sounds more agreeable than ‘I will’. And everything that is dear to you, you should first have commanded to you. Let your love towards life be love towards your highest hope: and let your highest hope be the highest idea of life! But you should let me commend to you your highest idea –and it is: Man is something that should be overcome. Thus live your life of obedience and war! What good is long life? What warrior wants to be spared? I do not spare you, I love you from the very heart, my brothers in war! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the New Idol T HERE are still peoples and herds somewhere, but not with us, my brothers: here there are states. The state? What is that? Well then! Now open your ears, for now I shall speak to you of the death of peoples. The state is the coldest of all cold monsters. Coldly it lies, too; and this lie creeps from its mouth: ‘I, the state, am the people.’ It is a lie! It was creators who created peoples and hung a faith and a love over them: thus they served life. It is destroyers who set snares for many and call it the state: they hang a sword and a hundred desires over them. Where a people still exists, there the people do not understand the state and hate it as the evil eye and sin against custom and law. I offer you this sign: every people speaks its own language of good and evil: its neighbour does not understand this language. It invented this language for itself in custom and law. But the state lies in all languages of good and evil; and whatever it says, it lies – and whatever it has, it has stolen. Everything about it is false; it bites with stolen teeth. Even its belly is false. Confusion of the language of good and evil; I offer you this sign as the sign of the state. Truly, this sign indicates the will to death! Truly, it beckons to the preachers of death! Many too many are born: the state was invented for the superfluous! Just see how it lures them, the many-too-many! How it devours

them, and chews them, and re-chews them! ‘There is nothing greater on earth than I, the regulating finger of God’ – thus the monster bellows. And not only the long-eared and short-sighted sink to their knees! Ah, it whispers its dismal lies to you too, you great souls! Ah, it divines the abundant hearts that like to squander themselves! Yes, it divines you too, you conquerors of the old God! You grew weary in battle and now your weariness serves the new idol! It would like to range heroes and honourable men about it, this new idol! It likes to sun itself in the sunshine of good consciences – this cold monster! It will give you everything if you worship it, this new idol: thus it buys for itself the lustre of your virtues and the glance of your proud eyes. It wants to use you to lure the many-too-many. Yes, a cunning device of Hell has here been devised, a horse of death jingling with the trappings of divine honours! Yes, a death for many has here been devised that glorifies itself as life: truly, a heart-felt service to all preachers of death! I call it the state where everyone, good and bad, is a poison-drinker: the state where everyone, good and bad, loses himself: the state where universal slow suicide is called – life. Just look at these superfluous people! They steal for themselves the works of inventors and the treasures of the wise: they call their theft culture – and they turn everything to sickness and calamity. Just look at these superfluous people! They are always ill, they vomit their bile and call it a newspaper. They devour one another and cannot even digest themselves. Just look at these superfluous people! They acquire wealth and make themselves poorer with it. They desire power and especially the lever of power, plenty of money – these impotent people! See them clamber, these nimble apes! They clamber over one another and so scuffle into the mud and the abyss. They all strive towards the throne: it is a madness they have – as if happiness sat upon the throne! Often filth sits upon the throne – and often the throne upon filth, too. They all seem madmen to me and clambering apes and too vehement. Their idol, that cold monster, smells unpleasant to me: all of them, all these idolaters, smell unpleasant to me. My brothers, do you then want to suffocate in the fumes of their animal mouths and appetites? Better to break the window and leap into the open air. Avoid this bad odour! Leave the idolatry of the superfluous! Avoid this bad odour! Leave the smoke of these human sacrifices! The earth still remains free for great souls. Many places – the odour of tranquil seas blowing about them – are still empty for solitaries and solitary couples. A free life still remains for great souls. Truly, he who possesses little is so much the less possessed: praised be a moderate poverty! Only there, where the state ceases, does the man who is not superfluous begin: does the song of the necessary man, the unique and irreplaceable melody, begin. There, where the state ceases – look there, my brothers. Do you not see it: the rainbow and the bridges to the Superman? Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Flies of the Market-place F LEE, my friend, into your solitude! I see you deafened by the uproar of the great men and pricked by the

stings of the small ones. Forest and rock know well how to be silent with you. Be like the tree again, the wide-branching tree that you love: calmly and attentively it leans out over the sea. Where solitude ceases, there the market-place begins; and where the market-place begins, there begins the uproar of the great actors and the buzzing of the poisonous flies. In the world even the best things are worthless apart from him who first presents them: people call these presenters 'great men'. The people have little idea of greatness, that is to say: creativeness. But they have a taste for all presenters and actors of great things. The world revolves about the inventor of new values: imperceptibly it revolves. But the people and the glory revolve around the actor: that is 'the way of the world'. The actor possesses spirit but little conscience of the spirit. 8 He always believes in that with which he most powerfully produces belief – produces belief in himself! Tomorrow he will have a new faith and the day after tomorrow a newer one. He has a quick perception, as the people have, and a capricious temperament. To overthrow – to him that means: to prove. To drive frantic – to him that means: to convince. And blood is to him the best of all arguments. A truth that penetrates only sensitive ears he calls a lie and a thing of nothing. Truly, he believes only in gods who make a great noise in the world! The market-place is full of solemn buffoons – and the people boast of their great men! These are their heroes of the hour. But the hour presses them: so they press you. And from you too they require a Yes or a No. And woe to you if you want to set your chair between For and Against. Do not be jealous, lover of truth, because of these inflexible and oppressive men! Truth has never yet clung to the arm of an inflexible man. Return to your security because of these abrupt men: only in the market-place is one assailed with Yes? or No? The experience of all deep wells is slow: they must wait long until they know what has fallen into their depths. All great things occur away from glory and the marketplace: the inventors of new values have always lived away from glory and the market-place. Flee, my friend, into your solitude: I see you stung by poisonous flies. Flee to where the raw, rough breeze blows! Flee into your solitude! You have lived too near the small and the pitiable men. Flee from their hidden vengeance! Towards you they are nothing but vengeance. No longer lift your arm against them! They are innumerable and it is not your fate to be a fly-swat. Innumerable are these small and pitiable men; and raindrops and weeds have already brought about the destruction of many a proud building. You are no stone, but already these many drops have made you hollow. You will yet break and burst apart through these many drops. I see you wearied by poisonous flies, I see you bloodily torn in a hundred places; and your pride refuses even to be angry. They want blood from you in all innocence, their bloodless souls thirst for blood – and therefore they sting in all innocence. But you, profound man, you suffer too profoundly even from small wounds; and before you have recovered, the same poison-worm is again crawling over your

hand. You are too proud to kill these sweet-toothed creatures. But take care that it does not become your fate to bear all their poisonous injustice! They buzz around you even with their praise: and their praise is importunity. They want to be near your skin and your blood. They flatter you as if you were a god or a devil; they whine before you as before a god or a devil. What of it! They are flatterers and whiners, and nothing more. And they are often kind to you. But that has always been the prudence of the cowardly. Yes, the cowardly are prudent! They think about you a great deal with their narrow souls -you are always suspicious to them. Everything that is thought about a great deal is finally thought suspicious. 9 They punish you for all your virtues. Fundamentally they forgive you only – your mistakes. Because you are gentle and just-minded, you say: ‘They are not to be blamed for their little existence.’ But their little souls think: ‘All great existence is blameworthy.’ Even when you are gentle towards them, they still feel you despise them; and they return your kindness with secret unkindness. Your silent pride always offends their taste; they rejoice if you are ever modest enough to be vain. When we recognize a peculiarity in a man we also inflame that peculiarity. So guard yourself against the small men! Before you, they feel themselves small, and their baseness glimmers and glows against you in hidden vengeance. Have you not noticed how often they became silent when you approached them, and how their strength left them like smoke from a dying fire? Yes, my friend, you are a bad conscience to your neighbours: for they are unworthy of you. Thus they hate you and would dearly like to suck your blood. Your neighbours will always be poisonous flies: that about you which is great, that itself must make them more poisonous and ever more fly-like. Flee, my friend, into your solitude and to where the raw, rough breeze blows! It is not your fate to be a fly-swat. Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of Chastity I LOVE the forest. It is bad to live in towns: too many of the lustful live there. Is it not better to fall into the hands of a murderer than into the dreams of a lustful woman? And just look at these men: their eye reveals it – they know of nothing better on earth than to lie with a woman. There is filth at the bottom of their souls; and it is worse if this filth still has something of the spirit in it! If only you had become perfect at least as animals! But to animals belongs innocence. Do I exhort you to kill your senses? I exhort you to an innocence of the senses. Do I exhort you to chastity? With some, chastity is a virtue, but with many it is almost a vice. These people abstain, it is true: but the bitch Sensuality glares enviously out of all they do. This restless beast follows them even into the heights of their virtue and the depths of their cold spirit. And how nicely the bitch Sensuality knows how to beg for a piece of spirit, when a piece of flesh is denied her. Do you love tragedies and all that is heartbreaking? But I mistrust your bitch Sensuality. Your eyes are too cruel for me; you look upon sufferers lustfully. Has your lasciviousness not merely disguised itself and called itself pity? And I offer you this parable: Not a

few who sought to drive out their devil entered into the swine themselves. Those to whom chastity is difficult should be dissuaded from it, lest it become the way to Hell – that is, to filth and lust of the soul. Am I speaking of dirty things? That does not seem to me the worst I could do. Not when truth is dirty, but when it is shallow, does the enlightened man dislike to wade into its waters. Truly, there are those who are chaste from the very heart: they are more gentle of heart and they laugh more often and more heartily than you. They laugh at chastity too, and ask: ‘What is chastity? ‘Is chastity not folly? But this folly came to us and not we to it. ‘We offered this guest love and shelter: now it lives with us – let it stay as long as it wishes!’ Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Friend ‘O NE is always one too many around me’ – thus speaks the hermit. ‘Always once one – in the long run that makes two!’ I and Me are always too earnestly in conversation with one another: how could it be endured, if there were not a friend? For the hermit the friend is always the third person: the third person is the cork that prevents the conversation of the other two from sinking to the depths. Alas, for all hermits there are too many depths. That is why they long so much for a friend and for his heights. Our faith in others betrays wherein we would dearly like to have faith in ourselves. Our longing for a friend is our betrayer. And often with our love we only want to leap over envy. And often we attack and make an enemy in order to conceal that we are vulnerable to attack. ‘At least be my enemy!’ – thus speaks the true reverence, that does not venture to ask for friendship. If you want a friend, you must also be willing to wage war for him: and to wage war, you must be capable of being an enemy. You should honour even the enemy in your friend. Can you go near to your friend without going over to him? In your friend you should possess your best enemy. Your heart should feel closest to him when you oppose him. Do you wish to go naked before your friend? Is it in honour of your friend that you show yourself to him as you are? But he wishes you to the Devil for it! He who makes no secret of himself excites anger in others: that is how much reason you have to fear nakedness! If you were gods you could then be ashamed of your clothes! You cannot adorn yourself too well for your friend: for you should be to him an arrow and a longing for the Superman. Have you ever watched your friend asleep – to discover what he looked like? Yet your friend’s face is something else beside. It is your own face, in a rough and imperfect mirror. Have you ever watched your friend asleep? Were you not startled to see what he looked like? O my friend, man is something that must be overcome. The friend should be a master in conjecture and in keeping silence: you must not want to see everything. Your dream should tell you what your friend does when awake. May your pity be a conjecture: that you may first know if your friend wants pity. Perhaps what he loves in you is the undimmed eye and the glance of eternity. Let your pity for your friend conceal itself under a hard shell; you should break a tooth biting upon it. Thus it will have delicacy and sweetness. Are

you pure air and solitude and bread and medicine to your friend? Many a one cannot deliver himself from his own chains and yet he is his friend's deliverer. Are you a slave? If so, you cannot be a friend. Are you a tyrant? If so, you cannot have friends. In woman, a slave and a tyrant have all too long been concealed. For that reason, woman is not yet capable of friendship: she knows only love. In a woman's love is injustice and blindness towards all that she does not love. And in the enlightened love of a woman, too, there is still the unexpected attack and lightning and night, along with the light. Woman is not yet capable of friendship: women ate still cats and birds. Or, at best, cows. Woman is not yet capable of friendship. But tell me, you men, which of you is yet capable of friendship? Oh your poverty, you men, and your avarice of soul! As much as you give to your friend I will give even to my enemy, and will not have grown poorer in doing so. There is comradeship: may there be friendship! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Thousand and One Goals ZARATHUSTRA has seen many lands and many peoples: thus he has discovered the good and evil of many peoples. Zarathustra has found no greater power on earth than good and evil. No people could live without evaluating; but if it wishes to maintain itself it must not evaluate as its neighbour evaluates. Much that seemed good to one people seemed shame and disgrace to another: thus I found. I found much that was called evil in one place was in another decked with purple honours. One neighbour never understood another: his soul was always amazed at his neighbour's madness and wickedness. A table of values hangs over every people. Behold, it is the table of its overcomings; behold, it is the voice of its will to power. What it accounts hard it calls praiseworthy; what it accounts indispensable and hard it calls good; and that which relieves the greatest need, the rare, the hardest of all – it glorifies as holy. Whatever causes it to rule and conquer and glitter, to the dread and envy of its neighbour, that it accounts the sublimest, the paramount, the evaluation and the meaning of all things. Truly, my brother, if you only knew a people's need and land and sky and neighbour, you could surely divine the law of its overcomings, and why it is upon this ladder that it mounts towards its hope. 'You should always be the first and outrival all others: your jealous soul should love no one, except your friend' -this precept made the soul of a Greek tremble: in following it he followed his path to greatness. 'To speak the truth and to know well how to handle bow and arrow' – this seemed both estimable and hard to that people from whom! got my name – a name which is both estimable and hard to me. 10 'To honour father and mother and to do their will even from the roots of the soul': another people hung this table of overcoming over itself and became mighty and eternal with it. 'To practise loyalty and for the sake of loyalty to risk honour and blood even in evil and dangerous causes': another people mastered itself with such teaching, and thus mastering itself it became pregnant and heavy with great hopes. Truly, men have given themselves all their good and evil. Truly,

they did not take it, they did not find it, it did not descend to them as a voice from heaven. Man first implanted values into things to maintain himself – he created the meaning of things, a human meaning! Therefore he calls himself: ‘Man’, that is: the evaluator. Evaluation is creation: hear it, you creative men! Valuating is itself the value and jewel of all valued things. Only through evaluation is there value: and without evaluation the nut of existence would be hollow. Hear it, you creative men! A change in values – that means a change in the creators of values. He who has to be a creator always has to destroy. Peoples were the creators at first; only later were individuals creators. Indeed, the individual himself is still the latest creation. Once the peoples hung a table of values over themselves. The love that wants to rule and the love that wants to obey created together such tables as these. Joy in the herd is older than joy in the Ego: and as long as the good conscience is called herd, only the bad conscience says: I. Truly, the cunning, loveless Ego, that seeks its advantage in the advantage of many – that is not the origin of the herd, but the herd’s destruction. It has always been creators and loving men who created good and evil. Fire of love and fire of anger glow in the names of all virtues. Zarathustra has seen many lands and many peoples: Zarathustra has found no greater power on earth than the works of these loving men: these works are named ‘good’ and ‘evil’. Truly, the power of this praising and blaming is a monster. Tell me, who will subdue it for me, brothers? Tell me, who will fasten fetters upon the thousand necks of this beast? Hitherto there have been a thousand goals, for there have been a thousand peoples. Only fetters are still lacking for these thousand necks, the one goal is still lacking. Yet tell me, my brothers: if a goal for humanity is still lacking, is there not still lacking – humanity itself? Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of Love of One’s Neighbour YOU crowd together with your neighbours and have beautiful words for it. But I tell you: Your love of your neighbour is your bad love of yourselves. You flee to your neighbour away from yourselves and would like to make a virtue of it: but I see through your ‘selflessness’. The ‘You’ is older than the ‘I’; the ‘You’ has been consecrated, but not yet the ‘I’: so man crowds towards his neighbour. Do I exhort you to love of your neighbour? I exhort you rather to flight from your neighbour and to love of the most distant! 11 Higher than love of one’s neighbour stands love of the most distant man and of the man of the future; higher still than love of man! account love of causes and of phantoms. This phantom that runs along behind you, my brother, is fairer than you; why do you not give it your flesh and bones? But you are afraid and you run to your neighbour. You cannot endure to be alone with yourselves and do not love yourselves enough: now you want to mislead your neighbour into love and gild yourselves with his mistake. I wish rather that you could not endure to be with any kind of neighbour or with your neighbour’s neighbour; then you would have to create your friend and his overflowing heart out of yourselves. You invite

in a witness when you want to speak well of yourselves; and when you have misled him into thinking well of you, you then think well of yourselves. It is not only he who speaks contrary to what he knows who lies, but even more he who speaks contrary to what he does not know. And thus you speak of yourselves in your dealings with others and deceive your neighbour with yourselves. Thus speaks the fool: 'Mixing with people ruins the character, especially when one has none.' One man runs to his neighbour because he is looking for himself, and another because he wants to lose himself. Your bad love of yourselves makes solitude a prison to you. It is the distant man who pays for your love of your neighbour; and when there are five of you together, a sixth always has to die. I do not like your festivals, either: I have found too many actors there, and the audience, too, behaved like actors. I do not teach you the neighbour but the friend. May the friend be to you a festival of the earth and a foretaste of the Superman. I teach you the friend and his overflowing heart. But you must understand how to be a sponge if you want to be loved by overflowing hearts. I teach you the friend in whom the world stands complete, a vessel of the good – the creative friend, who always has a complete world to bestow. And as the world once dispersed for him, so it comes back to him again, as the evolution of good through evil, as the evolution of design from chance. May the future and the most distant be the principle of your today: in your friend you should love the Superman as your principle. My brothers, I do not exhort you to love of your neighbour: I exhort you to love of the most distant. Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Way of the Creator M Y brother, do you want to go apart and be alone? Do you want to seek the way to yourself? Pause just a moment and listen to me. 'He who seeks may easily get lost himself. It is a crime to go apart and be alone' – thus speaks the herd. The voice of the herd will still ring within you. And when you say: 'We have no longer the same conscience, you and I', it will be a lament and a grief. For see, it is still this same conscience that causes your grief: and the last glimmer of this conscience still glows in your affliction. But you want to go the way of your affliction, which is the way to yourself? If so, show me your strength for it and your right to it! Are you a new strength and a new right? A first motion? A self-propelling wheel? Can you also compel stars to revolve about you? Alas, there is so much lusting for eminence! There is so much convulsion of the ambitious! Show me that you are not one of the lustful or ambitious! Alas, there are so many great ideas that do no more than a bellows: they inflate and make emptier. Do you call yourself free? I want to hear your ruling idea, and not that you have escaped from a yoke. Are you such a man as ought to escape a yoke? There are many who threw off their final worth when they threw off their bondage. Free from what? Zarathustra does not care about that! But your eye should clearly tell me: free for what? Can you furnish yourself with your own good and evil and hang up your own will above yourself as a law?

Can you be judge of yourself and avenger of your law? It is terrible to be alone with the judge and avenger of one's own law. It is to be like a star thrown forth into empty space and into the icy breath of solitude. Today you still suffer from the many, O man set apart: today you still have your courage whole and your hopes. But one day solitude will make you weary, one day your pride will bend and your courage break. One day you will cry: 'I am alone!' One day you will no longer see what is exalted in you; and what is base in you, you will see all too closely; your sublimity itself will make you afraid, as if it were a phantom. One day you will cry: 'Everything is false!' There are emotions that seek to kill the solitary; if they do not succeed, well, they must die themselves! But are you capable of being a murderer? My brother, have you ever known the word 'contempt'? And the anguish of your justice in being just to those who despise you? You compel many to change their opinion about you; they hold that very much against you. You approached them and yet went on past them: that they will never forgive you. You go above and beyond them: but the higher you climb, the smaller you appear to the eye of envy. And he who flies is hated most of all. 'How could you be just towards me?' – that is how you must speak – 'I choose your injustice as my portion.' They throw injustice and dirt at the solitary: but, my brother, if you want to be a star, you must shine none the less brightly for them on that account! And be on your guard against the good and just! They would like to crucify those who devise their own virtue -they hate the solitary. Be on your guard, too, against holy simplicity! Everything which is not simple is unholy to it: and it, too, likes to play, with fire – in this case, the fire of the stake. And be on your guard, too, against the assaults your love makes upon you! The solitary extends his hand too quickly to anyone he meets. To many men, you ought not to give your hand, but only your paw 12 : and I should like it if your paw had claws, too. But you yourself will always be the worst enemy you can encounter; you yourself lie in wait for yourself in caves and forests. Solitary man, you are going the way to yourself! And your way leads past yourself and your seven devils! You will be a heretic to yourself and a witch and a prophet and an evil-doer and a villain. You must be ready to burn yourself in your own flame: how could you become new, if you had not first become ashes? Solitary man, you are going the way of the creator: you want to create yourself a god from your seven devils! Solitary man, you are going the way of the lover: you love yourself and for that reason you despise yourself as only lovers can despise. The lover wants to create, because he despises! What does he know of love who has not had to despise precisely what he loved? Go apart and be alone with your love and your creating, my brother; and justice will be slow to limp after you. Go apart and be alone with my tears, my brother. I love him who wants to create beyond himself, and thus perishes. Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of Old and Young Women 'W HY do you slink so shyly through the twilight, Zarathustra? And what are

you hiding so carefully under your cloak? 'Is it a treasure someone has given you? Or a child that has been born to you? Or are you now taking the way of thieves yourself, friend of the wicked?' Truly, my brother! (said Zarathustra) it is a treasure that has been given me: it is a little truth that I carry. But it is as unruly as a little child, and if I do not stop its mouth it will cry too loudly. Today as I was going my way alone, at the hour when the sun sets, a little old woman encountered me and spoke thus to my soul: 'Zarathustra has spoken much to us women, too, but he has never spoken to us about woman.' And I answered her: 'One should speak about women only to men.' 'Speak to me too of woman,' she said; 'I am old enough soon to forget it.' And I obliged the little old woman and spoke to her thus: Everything about woman is a riddle, and everything about woman has one solution: it is called pregnancy. For the woman, the man is a means: the end is always the child. But what is the woman for the man? The true man wants two things: danger and play. For that reason he wants woman, as the most dangerous plaything. Man should be trained for war and woman for the recreation of the warrior: all else is folly. The warrior does not like fruit that is too sweet. Therefore he likes woman; even the sweetest woman is still bitter. Woman understands children better than a man, but man is more childlike than woman. A child is concealed in the true man: it wants to play. Come, women, discover the child in man! Let woman be a plaything, pure and fine like a precious stone illumined by the virtues of a world that does not yet exist. Let the flash of a star glitter in your level Let your hope be: 'May I bear the Superman!' Let there be bravery in your love! With your love you should attack him who inspires you with fear. Let your honour be in your love! Woman has understood little otherwise about honour. But let this be your honour: always to love more than you are loved and never to be second in this. Let man fear woman when she loves. Then she bears every sacrifice and every other thing she accounts valueless. Let man fear woman when she hates: for man is at the bottom of his soul only wicked, but woman is base. Whom does woman hate most? – Thus spoke the iron to the magnet: 'I hate you most, because you attract me, but are not strong enough to draw me towards you.' The man's happiness is: I will. The woman's happiness is: He will. 'Behold, now the world has become perfect!' – thus thinks every woman when she obeys with all her love. And woman has to obey and find a depth for her surface. Woman's nature is surface, a changeable, stormy film upon shallow waters. But a man's nature is deep, its torrent roars in subterranean caves: woman senses its power but does not comprehend it. Then the little old woman answered me: 'Zarathustra has said many nice things, especially for those who are young enough for them. 'It is strange, Zarathustra knows little of women and yet he is right about them! Is this because with women nothing is impossible? 'And now accept as thanks a little truth 11 am certainly old enough for it! 'Wrap it up and stop its mouth: otherwise it will cry

too loudly, this little truth!’ ‘Give me your little truth, woman!’ I said. And thus spoke the little old woman: ‘Are you visiting women? Do not forget your whip!’ Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Adder’s Bite O NE day Zarathustra had fallen asleep under a fig tree because of the heat, and had laid his arms over his face. An adder came along and bit him in the neck, so that Zarathustra cried out with pain. When he had taken his arm from his face he regarded the snake: it recognized Zarathustra’s eyes, turned away awkwardly and was about to go. ‘No, don’t go,’ said Zarathustra; ‘you have not yet received my thanks! You have awakened me at the right time, I still have a long way to go.’ ‘You have only a short way to go,’ said the adder sadly, ‘my poison is deadly.’ Zarathustra smiled. ‘When did a dragon ever die from the poison of a snake?’ he said. ‘But take your poison back! You are not rich enough to give it me!’ Then the adder fell upon his neck again and licked his wound. When Zarathustra once told this to his disciples, they asked: ‘And what, O Zarathustra, is the moral of your story?’ Zarathustra answered the question thus: The good and just call me the destroyer of morals: my story is immoral. When, however, you have an enemy, do not requite him good for evil: for that would make him ashamed. But prove that he has done something good to you. Better to be angry than make ashamed! And when you are cursed, I do not like it that you then want to bless. Rather curse back a little! And should a great injustice be done you, then quickly do five little injustices besides. He who bears injustice alone is terrible to behold. Did you know this already? Shared injustice is half justice. And he who can bear it should take the injustice upon himself. A little revenge is more human than no revenge at all. And if the punishment be not also a right and an honour for the transgressor, then I do not like your punishment. It is more noble to declare yourself wrong than to maintain you are right, especially when you are right. Only you must be rich enough for it. I do not like your cold justice; and from the eye of your judges there always gazes only the executioner and his cold steel. Tell me, where is the justice which is love with seeing eyes to be found? Then devise the love that bears not only all punishment but also all guilt! Then devise the justice that acquits everyone except the judges! Will you learn this, too? To him who wants to be just from the very heart even a lie becomes philanthropy. But how could I be just from the very heart? How can I give everyone what is his? Let this suffice me: I give everyone what is mine. Finally, my brothers, guard yourselves against doing wrong to any hermit! How could a hermit forget? How could he requite? A hermit is like a deep well. It is easy to throw a stone into it; but if it sink to the bottom, tell me, who shall fetch it out again? Guard yourselves against offending the hermit! But if you have done so, well then, kill him as well! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of Marriage and Children I HAVE a question for you alone, my brother: I throw this question like a plummet into your soul, to discover how deep it is. You are young and desire marriage and

children. But I ask you: are you a man who ought to desire a child? Are you the victor, the self-conqueror, the ruler of your senses, the lord of your virtues? Thus I ask you. Or do the animal and necessity speak from your desire? Or isolation? Or disharmony with yourself? I would have your victory and your freedom long for a child. You should build living memorials to your victory and your liberation. You should build beyond yourself. But first you must be built yourself, square-built in body and soul. You should propagate yourself not only forward, but upward! 13 May the garden of marriage help you to do it! You should create a higher body, a first motion, a self-propelling wheel – you should create a creator. Marriage: that I call the will of two to create the one who is more than those who created it. Reverence before one another, as before the willers of such a will – that I call marriage. Let this be the meaning and the truth of your marriage. But that which the many-too-many, the superfluous, call marriage – ah, what shall I call it? Ah, this poverty of soul in partnership! Ah, this filth of soul in partnership! Ah, this miserable ease in partnership! All this they call marriage; and they say their marriages are made in Heaven. Well, I do not like it, this Heaven of the superfluous! No, I do not like them, these animals caught in the heavenly net! And let the God who limps hither to bless what he has not joined stay far from me! Do not laugh at such marriages! What child has not had reason to weep over its parents? This man seemed to me worthy and ripe for the meaning of the earth: but when I saw his wife the earth seemed to me a house for the nonsensical. Yes, I wish that the earth shook with convulsions when a saint and a goose mate together. This man set forth like a hero in quest of truth and at last he captured a little dressed-up lie. He calls it his marriage. That man used to be reserved in his dealings and fastidious in his choice. But all at once he spoilt his company once and for all: he calls it his marriage. That man sought a handmaiden with the virtues of an angel. But all at once he became the handmaiden of a woman, and now he needs to become an angel too. I have found all buyers cautious, and all of them have astute eyes. But even the most astute man buys his wife while she is still wrapped. Many brief follies – that is called love with you. And your marriage makes an end of many brief follies with one long stupidity. Your love for woman and woman's love for man: ah, if only it were pity for suffering and veiled gods! But generally two animals sense one another. But even your best love too is only a passionate impersonation and a painful ardour. It is a torch which should light your way to higher paths. One day you shall love beyond yourselves! So first learn to love! For that you have had to drink the bitter cup of your love. There is bitterness in the cup of even the best love: thus it arouses longing for the Superman, thus it arouses thirst in you, the creator! A creator's thirst, arrow, and longing for the Superman: speak, my brother, is this your will to marriage? I call holy such a will and such a marriage. Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of Voluntary Death M ANY die too late and some die

too early. Still the doctrine sounds strange: 'Die at the right time.' Die at the right time: thus Zarathustra teaches. To be sure, he who never lived at the right time could hardly die at the right time! Better if he were never to be born! – Thus I advise the superfluous. But even the superfluous make a great thing of their dying; yes, even the hollowest nut wants to be cracked. Everyone treats death as an important matter: but as yet death is not a festival. As yet, men have not learned to consecrate the fairest festivals. I shall show you the consummating death, which shall be a spur and a promise to the living. The man consummating his life dies his death triumphantly, surrounded by men filled with hope and making solemn vows. Thus one should learn to die; and there should be no festivals at which such a dying man does not consecrate the oaths of the living! To die thus is the best death; but the second best is: to die in battle and to squander a great soul. But equally hateful to the fighter as to the victor is your grinning death, which comes creeping up like a thief – and yet comes as master. I commend to you my sort of death, voluntary death that comes to me because I wish it. And when shall I wish it? – He who has a goal and an heir wants death at the time most favourable to his goal and his heir. And out of reverence for his goal and his heir he will hang up no more withered wreaths in the sanctuary of life. Truly, I do not want to be like the rope-makers: they spin out their yarn and as a result continually go backwards themselves. Many a one grows too old even for his truths and victories; a toothless mouth has no longer the right to every truth. And everyone who wants glory must take leave of honour in good time and practise the difficult art of – going at the right time. One must stop permitting oneself to be eaten when one tastes best: this is understood by those who want to be loved long. To be sure, there are sour apples whose fate is to wait until the last day of autumn: and they become at the same time ripe, yellow, and shrivelled. In some the heart ages first and in others the spirit. And some are old in their youth: but those who are young late stay young long. For many a man, life is a failure: a poison-worm eats at his heart. So let him see to it that his death is all the more a success. Many a man never becomes sweet, he rots even in the summer. It is cowardice that keeps him fastened to his branch. Many too many live and they hang on their branches much too long. I wish a storm would come and shake all this rottenness and worm-eatenness from the tree! I wish preachers of speedy death would come! They would be the fitting storm and shakers of the trees of life! But I hear preached only slow death and patience with all 'earthly things'. Ah, do you preach patience with earthly things? It is these earthly things that have too much patience with you, you blasphemers! Truly, too early died that Hebrew whom the preachers of slow death honour: and that he died too early has since been a fatality for many. As yet he knew only tears and the melancholy of the Hebrews, together with the hatred of the good and just -the Hebrew Jesus: then he was seized by the longing for death. Had he only remained in the desert

and far from the good and just! Perhaps he would have learned to live and learned to love the earth – and laughter as well! Believe it, my brothers! He died too early; he himself would have recanted his teaching had he lived to my age! He was noble enough to recant! But he was still immature. The youth loves immaturity and immaturity too he hates man and the earth. His heart and the wings of his spirit are still bound and heavy. But there is more child in the man than in the youth, and less melancholy: he has a better understanding of life and death. Free for death and free in death, one who solemnly says No when there is no longer time for Yes: thus he understands life and death. That your death may not be a blasphemy against man and the earth, my friends: that is what I beg from the honey of your soul. In your death, your spirit and your virtue should still glow like a sunset glow around the earth: otherwise yours is a bad death. Thus I want to die myself, that you friends may love the earth more for my sake; and I want to become earth again, that I may have peace in her who bore me. Truly, Zarathustra had a goal, he threw his ball: now may you friends be the heirs of my goal, I throw the golden ball to you. But best of all I like to see you, too, throwing on the golden ball, my friends! So I shall stay on earth a little longer: forgive me for it! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Bestowing Virtue 1

WHEN Zarathustra had taken leave of the town to which his heart was attached and which was called ‘The Pied Cow’ there followed him many who called themselves his disciples and escorted him. Thus they came to a cross-road: there Zarathustra told them that from then on he wanted to go alone: for he was a friend of going-alone. But his disciples handed him in farewell a staff, upon the golden haft of which a serpent was coiled about a sun. Zarathustra was delighted with the staff and leaned upon it; then he spoke thus to his disciples: Tell me: how did gold come to have the highest value? Because it is uncommon and useless and shining and mellow in lustre; it always bestows itself. Only as an image of the highest virtue did gold come to have the highest value. Gold-like gleams the glance of the giver. Gold-lustre makes peace between moon and sun. The highest virtue is uncommon and useless, it is shining and mellow in lustre: the highest virtue is a bestowing virtue. Truly, I divine you well, my disciples, you aspire to the bestowing virtue, as I do. What could you have in common with cats and wolves? You thirst to become sacrifices and gifts yourselves; and that is why you thirst to heap up all riches in your soul. Your soul aspires insatiably after treasures and jewels, because your virtue is insatiable in wanting to give. You compel all things to come to you and into you, that they may flow back from your fountain as gifts of your love. Truly, such a bestowing love must become a thief of all values; but I call this selfishness healthy and holy. There is another selfishness, an all-too-poor, a hungry selfishness that always wants to steal, that selfishness of the sick, the sick selfishness. It looks with the eye of a thief upon all lustrous things; with the greed of hunger it measures him who has plenty to

eat; and it is always skulking about the table of the givers. Sickness speaks from such craving, and hidden degeneration; the thieving greed of this longing speaks of a sick body. Tell me, my brothers: what do we account bad and the worst of all? Is it not degeneration? – And we always suspect degeneration where the bestowing soul is lacking. Our way is upward, from the species across to the super-species. But the degenerate mind which says ‘All for me’ is a horror to us. Our mind flies upward: thus it is an image of our bodies, an image of an advance and elevation. The names of the virtues are such images of advances and elevations. Thus the body goes through history, evolving and battling. And the spirit – what is it to the body? The herald, companion, and echo of its battles and victories. All names of good and evil are images: they do not speak out, they only hint. He is a fool who seeks knowledge from them. Whenever your spirit wants to speak in images, pay heed; for that is when your virtue has its origin and beginning. Then your body is elevated and risen up; it enraptures the spirit with its joy, that it may become creator and evaluator and lover and benefactor of all things. When your heart surges broad and full like a river, a blessing and a danger to those who live nearby: that is when your virtue has its origin and beginning. When you are exalted above praise and blame, and your will wants to command all things as the will of a lover: that is when your virtue has its origin and beginning. When you despise the soft bed and what is pleasant and cannot make your bed too far away from the soft-hearted: that is when your virtue has its origin and beginning. When you are the willers of a single will, and you call this dispeller of need your essential and necessity: that is when your virtue has its origin and beginning. Truly, it is a new good and evil! Truly, a new roaring in the depths and the voice of a new fountain! It is power, this new virtue; it is a ruling idea, and around it a subtle soul: a golden sun, and around it the serpent of knowledge. 2 Here Zarathustra fell silent a while and regarded his disciples lovingly. Then he went on speaking thus, and his voice was different: Stay loyal to the earth, my brothers, with the power of your virtue! May your bestowing love and your knowledge serve towards the meaning of the earth! Thus I beg and entreat you. Do not let it fly away from the things of earth and beat with its wings against the eternal walls! Alas, there has always been much virtue that has flown away! Lead, as I do, the flown-away virtue back to earth – yes, back to body and life: that it may give the earth its meaning, a human meaning! A hundred times hitherto has spirit as well as virtue flown away and blundered. Alas, all this illusion and blundering still dwells in our bodies: it has there become body and will. A hundred times has spirit as well as virtue experimented and gone astray. Yes, man was an experiment. Alas, much ignorance and error has become body in us! Not only the reason of millennia – the madness of millennia too breaks out in us. It is dangerous to be an heir. We are still fighting step by step with the giant Chance, and hitherto the senseless, the meaningless,

has still ruled over mankind. May your spirit and your virtue serve the meaning of the earth, my brothers: and may the value of all things be fixed anew by you. To that end you should be fighters! To that end you should be creators! The body purifies itself through knowledge; experimenting with knowledge it elevates itself; to the discerning man all instincts are holy; the soul of the elevated man grows joyful. Physician, heal yourself: thus you will heal your patient too. Let his best healing-aid be to see with his own eyes him who makes himself well. There are a thousand paths that have never yet been trodden, a thousand forms of health and hidden islands of life. Man and man's earth are still unexhausted and undiscovered. Watch and listen, you solitaries! From the future come winds with a stealthy flapping of wings; and good tidings go out to delicate ears. You solitaries of today, you who have seceded from society, you shall one day be a people: from you, who have chosen out yourselves, shall a chosen people spring – and from this chosen people, the Superman. Truly, the earth shall yet become a house of healing! And already a new odour floats about it, an odour that brings health – and a new hope! 3 When Zarathustra had said these words he paused like one who has not said his last word; long he balanced the staff doubtfully in his hand. At last he spoke thus, and his voice was different: I now go away alone, my disciples! You too now go away and be alone! So I will have it. Truly, I advise you: go away from me and guard yourselves against Zarathustra! And better still: be ashamed of him! Perhaps he has deceived you. The man of knowledge must be able not only to love his enemies but also to hate his friends. One repays a teacher badly if one remains only a pupil. And why, then, should you not pluck at my laurels? You respect me; but how if one day your respect should tumble? Take care that a falling statue does not strike you dead! You say you believe in Zarathustra? But of what importance is Zarathustra? You are my believers: but of what importance are all believers? You had not yet sought yourselves when you found me. Thus do all believers; therefore all belief is of so little account. Now I bid you lose me and find yourselves; and only when you have all denied me will I return to you. Truly, with other eyes, my brothers, I shall then seek my lost ones; with another love I shall then love you. And once more you shall have become my friends and children of one hope: and then I will be with you a thud time, that I may celebrate the great noontide with you. And this is the great noontide: it is when man stands at the middle of his course between animal and Superman and celebrates his journey to the evening as his highest hope: for it is the journey to a new morning. Then man, going under, will bless himself; for he will be going over to Superman; and the sun of his knowledge will stand at noontide. ‘ All gods are dead: now we want the Superman to live ’ – let this be our last will one day at the great noontide! Thus spoke Zarathustra. PART TWO ‘ – and only when you have all denied me will I return to you ‘ Truly, with other eyes, my brothers, I shall then seek my lost

ones,' with another love I shall then love you . ' ZARATHUSTRA: ' Of the Bestowing Virtue ' The Child with the Mirror T HEN Zarathustra went back into the mountains and into the solitude of his cave and withdrew from mankind: waiting like a sower who has scattered his seed. His soul, however, became full of impatience and longing for those whom he loved: for he still had much to give them. This, indeed, is the most difficult thing: to close the open hand out of love and to preserve one's modesty as a giver. Thus months and years passed over the solitary; but his wisdom increased and caused him pain by its abundance. One morning, however, he awoke before dawn, deliberated long upon his bed, and at length spoke to his heart: Why was I so frightened in my dream that I awoke? Did not a child carrying a mirror come to me? 'O Zarathustra,' the child said to me, 'look at yourself in the mirror!' But when I looked into the mirror I cried out and my heart was shaken: for I did not see myself, I saw the sneer and grimace of a devil. Truly, I understand the dream's omen and warning all too well: my doctrine is in danger, weeds want to be called wheat! My enemies have grown powerful and have distorted the meaning of my doctrine, so that my dearest ones are ashamed of the gifts I gave them. My friends are lost to me; the hour has come to seek my lost ones! With these words Zarathustra sprang up – not, however, as if gasping for air, but rather like a seer and a singer whom the spirit has moved. His eagle and his serpent regarded him with amazement: for a dawning happiness lit up his face like the dawn. What has happened to me, my animals? (said Zarathustra). Have I not changed? Has bliss not come to me like a storm-wind? My happiness is foolish and it will speak foolish things: it is still too young – so be patient with ill My happiness has wounded me: all sufferers shall be physicians to me! I can go down to my friends again and to my enemies too! Zarathustra can speak and give again, and again show love to those he loves. My impatient love overflows in torrents down towards morning and evening. My soul streams into the valleys out of silent mountains and storms of grief. I have desired and gazed into the distance too long. I have belonged to solitude too long: thus I have forgotten how to be silent. I have become nothing but speech and the tumbling of a brook from high rocks: I want to hurl my words down into the valleys. And let my stream of love plunge into impassable and pathless places! How should a stream not find its way to the sea at last! There is surely a lake in me, a secluded, self-sufficing lake; but my stream of love draws it down with it – to the sea! I go new ways, a new speech has come to me; like all creators, I have grown weary of the old tongues. My spirit no longer wants to walk on worn-out soles. All speech runs too slowly for me – I leap into your chariot, storm! And even you! will whip on with my venom! I want to sail across broad seas like a cry and a shout of joy, until I find the Blissful Islands where my friends are waiting – And my enemies with them! How I now love anyone to whom I can simply speak! My enemies too are part of my happiness. And when I

want to mount my wildest horse, it is my spear that best helps me on to it; it is an ever-ready servant to my foot – The spear which I throw at my enemies! How I thank my enemies that at last I can throw it! The tension of my cloud has been too great: between laughter-peals of lightning I want to cast hail showers into the depths. Mightily then my breast will heave, mightily it will blow its storm away over the mountains: and so it will win relief. Truly, my happiness and my freedom come like a storm! But my enemies shall think the Evil One is raging over their heads. Yes, you too, my friends, will be terrified by my wild wisdom; and perhaps you will flee from it together with my enemies. Ah, if only I knew how to lure you back with shepherds' flutes! Ah, if only my lioness Wisdom had learned to roar fondly! And we have already learned so much with one another! My wild Wisdom became pregnant upon lonely mountains; upon rough rocks she bore her young, her youngest. Now she runs madly through the cruel desert and seeks and seeks for the soft grassland – my old, wild Wisdom! Upon the soft grassland of your hearts, my friends! – upon your love she would like to bed her dearest one! Thus spoke Zarathustra. On the Blissful Islands THE figs are falling from the trees, they are fine and sweet; and as they fall their red skins split. I am a north wind to ripe figs. Thus, like figs, do these teachings fall to you, my friends: now drink their juice and eat their sweet flesh! It is autumn all around and clear sky and afternoon. Behold, what abundance is around us! And it is fine to gaze out upon distant seas from the midst of superfluity. Once you said 'God' when you gazed upon distant seas; but now I have taught you to say 'Superman'. God is a supposition; but I want your supposing to teach no further than your creating will. Could you create a god? – So be silent about all gods! But you could surely create the Superman. Perhaps not you yourselves, my brothers! But you could transform yourselves into forefathers and ancestors of the Superman: and let this be your finest creating! God is a supposition: but I want your supposing to be bounded by conceivability. Could you conceive a god? – But may the will to truth mean this to you: that everything shall be transformed into the humanly-conceivable, the humanly-evident, the humanly-palpable! You should follow your own senses to the end! And you yourselves should create what you have hitherto called the World: the World should be formed in your image by your reason, your will, and your love! And truly, it will be to your happiness, you enlightened men! And how should you endure life without this hope, you enlightened men? Neither in the incomprehensible nor in the irrational can you be at home. But to reveal my heart entirely to you, friends: if there were gods, how could I endure not to be a god! Therefore there are no gods. I, indeed, drew that conclusion; but now it draws me. God is a supposition: but who could imbibe all the anguish of this supposition without dying? Shall the creator be robbed of his faith and the eagle of his soaring into the heights? God is a thought that makes all that is straight crooked and all that stands giddy. What? Would

time be gone and all that is transitory only a lie? To think this is giddiness and vertigo to the human frame, and vomiting to the stomach: truly, I call it the giddy sickness to suppose such a thing. I call it evil and misanthropic, all this teaching about the one and the perfect and the unmoved and the sufficient and the intransitory. All that is intransitory – that is but an image! 14 And the poets lie too much. But the best images and parables should speak of time and becoming: they should be a eulogy and a justification of all transitoriness. Creation – that is the great redemption from suffering, and life's easement. But that the creator may exist, that itself requires suffering and much transformation. Yes, there must be much bitter dying in your life, you creators! Thus you are advocates and justifiers of all transitoriness. For the creator himself to be the child new-born he must also be willing to be the mother and endure the mother's pain. Truly, I have gone my way through a hundred souls and through a hundred cradles and birth-pangs. I have taken many departures, I know the heart-breaking last hours. But my creative will, my destiny, wants it so. Or, to speak more honestly: my will wants precisely such a destiny. All feeling suffers in me and is in prison: but my willing always comes to me as my liberator and bringer of joy. Willing liberates: that is the true doctrine of will and freedom – thus Zarathustra teaches you. No more to will and no more to evaluate and no more to create! ah, that this great lassitude may ever stay far from me! In knowing and understanding, too, I feel only my will's delight in begetting and becoming; and if there be innocence in my knowledge it is because will to begetting is in it. This will lured me away from God and gods; for what would there be to create if gods – existed! But again and again it drives me to mankind, my ardent, creative will; thus it drives the hammer to the stone. Ah, you men, I see an image sleeping in the stone, the image of my visions! Ah, that it must sleep in the hardest, ugliest stone! Now my hammer rages fiercely against its prison. Fragments fly from the stone: what is that to me? I will complete it: for a shadow came to me – the most silent, the lightest of all things once came to me! The beauty of the Superman came to me as a shadow. Ah, my brothers! What are the gods to me now! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Compassionate M Y friends, your friend has heard a satirical saying: 'Just look at Zarathustra! Does he not go among us as if among animals?' But it is better said like this: 'The enlightened man goes among men as among animals.' The enlightened man calls man himself: the animal with red cheeks. How did this happen to man? Is it not because he has had to be ashamed too often? Oh my friends! Thus speaks the enlightened man: 'Shame, shame, shame – that is the history of man!' And for that reason the noble man resolves not to make others ashamed: he resolves to feel shame before all sufferers. Truly, I do not like them, the compassionate who are happy in their compassion: they are too lacking in shame. If I must be compassionate I still do not want to be called compassionate; and if I am compassionate then it is preferably from a distance. And I should also

prefer to cover my head and flee away before I am recognised: and thus I bid you do, my friends! May my destiny ever lead across my path only those who, like you, do not sorrow or suffer, and those with whom I can have hope and repast and honey in common! Truly, I did this and that for the afflicted; but it always seemed to me I did better things when I learned to enjoy myself better. As long as men have existed, man has enjoyed himself too little: that alone, my brothers, is our original sin! And if we learn better to enjoy ourselves, we best unlearn how to do harm to others and to contrive harm. Therefore I wash my hand when it has helped a sufferer, therefore I wipe my soul clean as well. For I saw the sufferer suffer, and because I saw it I was ashamed on account of his shame; and when I helped him, then I sorely injured his pride. Great obligations do not make a man grateful, they make him resentful; and if a small kindness is not forgotten it becomes a gnawing worm. ‘Be reserved in accepting! Honour a man by accepting from him!’ – thus I advise those who have nothing to give. I, however, am a giver: I give gladly as a friend to friends. But strangers and the poor may pluck the fruit from my tree for themselves: it causes less shame that way. Beggars, however, should be entirely abolished! Truly, it is annoying to give to them and annoying not to give to them. And likewise sinners and bad consciences! Believe me, my friends: stings of conscience teach one to sting. But worst of all are petty thoughts. Truly, better even to have done wickedly than to have thought pettily! To be sure, you will say: ‘Delight in petty wickedness spares us many a great evil deed.’ But here one should not wish to be spared. The evil deed is like a boil: it itches and irritates and breaks forth – it speaks honourably. ‘Behold, I am disease’ – thus speaks the evil deed; that is its honesty. But the petty thought is like a canker: it creeps and hides and wants to appear nowhere – until the whole body is rotten and withered by little cankers. But I whisper this advice in the ear of him possessed of a devil: ‘Better for you to rear your devil! There is a way to greatness even for you!’ Ah, my brothers! One knows a little too much about everybody! And many a one who has become transparent to us is still for a long time invulnerable. It is hard to live with men, because keeping silent is so hard. And we are the most unfair, not towards him whom we do not like, but towards him for whom we feel nothing at all. But if you have a suffering friend, be a resting-place for his suffering, but a resting-place like a hard bed, a camp-bed: thus you will serve him best. And should your friend do you a wrong, then say: ‘I forgive you what you did to me; but that you did it to yourself – how could I forgive that?’ Thus speaks all great love: it overcomes even forgiveness and pity. One should hold fast to one’s heart; for if one lets it go, how soon one loses one’s head, too! Alas, where in the world have there been greater follies than with the compassionate? And what in the world has caused more suffering than the follies of the compassionate? Woe to all lovers who cannot surmount pity! Thus spoke the Devil to me once: ‘Even God

has his Hell: it is his love for man.' And I lately heard him say these words: 'God is dead; God has died of his pity for man.' So be warned against pity: thence shall yet come a heavy cloud for man! Truly, I understand weather-signs! But mark, too, this saying: All great love is above pity: for it wants – to create what is loved! 'I offer myself to my love, and my neighbour as myself' – that is the language of all creators. All creators, however, are hard. Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Priests AND one day Zarathustra made a sign to his disciples and spoke these words to them: Here are priests: and although they are my enemies, pass them by quietly and with sleeping swords! There are heroes even among them; many of them have suffered too much: so they want to make others suffer. They are bad enemies: nothing is more revengeful than their humility. And he who touches them is easily defiled. But my blood is related to theirs; and I want to know my blood honoured even in theirs. And when they had passed by, Zarathustra was assailed by a pain; and he had not struggled long with his pain when he began to speak thus: I pity these priests. They go against my taste, too; but that means little to me since I am among men. But I suffer and have suffered with them: they seem to me prisoners and marked men. He whom they call Redeemer has cast them into bondage - Into the bondage of false values and false scriptures! Ah, that someone would redeem them from their Redeemer! Once, as the sea tossed them about, they thought they had landed upon an island; but behold, it was a sleeping monster! False values and false scriptures: they are the worst monsters for mortal men – fate sleeps and waits long within them. But at last it comes and awakes and eats and devours all that have built their huts upon it. Oh, just look at these huts that these priests have built themselves. Churches they call their sweet-smelling caves! Oh this counterfeit light! oh this musty air I here, where the soul may not fly up to its height! On the contrary, their faith commands: 'Up the steps on your knees, you sinners!' Truly, I would rather see men still shameless than with the distorted eyes of their shame and devotion! Who created such caves and penitential steps? Was it not those who wanted to hide themselves and were ashamed before the clear sky? And only when the clear sky again looks through broken roofs and down upon grass and red poppies on broken walls – only then will I turn my heart again towards the places of this God. They called God that which contradicted and harmed them: and truly, there was much that was heroic in their worship! And they knew no other way of loving their God than by nailing men to the Cross! They thought to live as corpses, they dressed their corpses in black; even in their speech I still smell the evil aroma of burial vaults. And he who lives in their neighbourhood lives in the neighbourhood of black pools, from out of which the toad, that prophet of evil, sings its song with sweet melancholy. They would have to sing better songs to make me believe in their Redeemer: his disciples would have to look more redeemed! I should like to see them naked: for beauty alone should preach

penitence. But whom could this disguised affliction persuade! Truly, their Redeemers themselves did not come from freedom and the seventh heaven of freedom! Truly, they themselves never trod upon the carpets of knowledge! The spirit of their Redeemers consisted of holes; but into every hole they had put their illusion, their stop-gap, which they called God. Their spirit was drowned in their pity, and when they swelled and overswelled with pity a great folly always swam to the top. Zealously and with clamour they drove their herds over their bridge: as if there were only one bridge to the future! Truly, these shepherds, too, still belonged among the sheep! These shepherds had small intellects and spacious souls: but, my brothers, what small countries have even the most spacious souls been, up to now! They wrote letters of blood on the path they followed, and their folly taught that truth is proved by blood. But blood is the worst witness of truth; blood poisons and transforms the purest teaching to delusion and hatred of the heart. And if someone goes through fire for his teaching – what does that prove? Truly, it is more when one's own teaching comes out of one's own burning! Sultry heart and cold head: where these meet there arises the blusterer, the 'Redeemer'. Truly, there have been greater men and higher-born ones than those whom the people call Redeemer, those ravishing and overpowering blustering winds! And you, my brothers, must be redeemed by greater men than any Redeemer has been, if you would find the way to freedom! There has never yet been a Superman. I have seen them both naked, the greatest and the smallest man. They are still all-too-similar to one another. Truly, I found even the greatest man – all-too-human! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Virtuous ONE has to speak with thunder and heavenly fireworks to feeble and dormant senses. But the voice of beauty speaks softly: it steals into only the most awakened souls. Gently my mirror trembled and laughed to me today; it was beauty's holy laughter and trembling. My beauty laughed at you, you virtuous, today. And thus came its voice to me: 'They want to be – paid as well!' You want to be paid as well, you virtuous! Do you want reward for virtue and heaven for earth and eternity for your today? And are you now angry with me because I teach that there is no reward-giver nor paymaster? And truly, I do not even teach that virtue is its own reward. Alas, this is my sorrow: reward and punishment have been lyingly introduced into the foundation of things – and now even into the foundation of your souls, you virtuous! But my words, like the snout of the boar, shall tear up the foundations of your souls; you shall call me a ploughshare. All the secrets of your heart shall be brought to light; and when you lie, grubbed up and broken, in the sunlight, then your falsehood will be separated from your truth. For this is your truth: You are too pure for the dirt of the words: revenge, punishment, reward, retribution. You love your virtue as the mother her child; but when was it heard of a mother wanting to be paid for her love? Your virtue is your dearest self. The ring's desire is in you: to attain itself again – every ring

struggles and turns itself to that end. And every work of your virtue is like a star extinguished: its light is for ever travelling – and when will it cease from travelling? Thus the light of your virtue is still travelling even when its task is done. Though it be forgotten and dead, its beam of light still lives and travels. That your virtue is your Self and not something alien, a skin, a covering: that is the truth from the bottom of your souls, you virtuous! But there are indeed those to whom virtue is a writhing under the whip: and you have listened too much to their cries! And with others, their vices grow lazy and they call that virtue; and once their hatred and jealousy stretch themselves to rest, their ‘justice’ becomes lively and rubs its sleepy eyes. And there are others who are drawn downward: their devils draw them. But the more they sink, the more brightly shines their eye and the longing for their God. Alas, their cry, too, has come to your ears, you virtuous: ‘What I am not, that, that to me is God and virtue!’ And there are others who go along, heavy and creaking, like carts carrying stones downhill: they speak much of dignity and virtue – their brake they call virtue! And there are others who are like household clocks wound up; they repeat their tick-tock and want people to call tick-tock – virtue. Truly, I have fun with these: wherever I find such clocks I shall wind them up with my mockery; let them chime as well as tick! And others are proud of their handful of righteousness and for its sake commit wanton outrage upon all things: so that the world is drowned in their unrighteousness. Alas, how ill the word ‘virtue’ sounds in their mouths! And when they say: ‘I am just,’ it always sounds like: ‘I am revenged!’ 15 They want to scratch out the eyes of their enemies with their virtue; and they raise themselves only in order to lower others. And again, there are those who sit in their swamp and speak thus from the rushes: ‘Virtue – that means to sit quietly in the swamp. ‘We bite nobody and avoid him who wants to bite: and in everything we hold the opinion that is given us.’ And again, there are those who like posing and think: Virtue is a sort of pose. Their knees are always worshipping and their hands are glorifications of virtue, but their heart knows nothing of it. And again, there are those who hold it a virtue to say: ‘Virtue is necessary’; but fundamentally they believe only that the police are necessary. And many a one who cannot see the sublime in man calls it virtue that he can see his baseness all-too-closely: thus he calls his evil eye virtue. And some want to be edified and raised up and call it virtue; and others want to be thrown down – and call it virtue too. And in that way almost everyone firmly believes he is participating in virtue; and at least asserts he is an expert on ‘good’ and ‘evil’. But Zarathustra has not come to say to all these liars and fools: ‘What do you know of virtue? What could you know of virtue?’ No, he has come that you, my friends, might grow weary of the old words you have learned from the fools and liars. That you might grow weary of the words ‘reward’, ‘retribution’, ‘punishment’, ‘righteous revenge’. That you might grow weary of saying: ‘An action is good when it is

unselfish.' Ah, my friends I That your Self be in the action, as the mother is in the child: let that be your maxim of virtue! Truly, I have taken a hundred maxims and your virtues' dearest playthings away from you; and you scold me now, as children scold. They were playing on the sea-shore – then came a wave and swept their playthings into the deep: now they cry. But the same wave shall bring them new playthings and pour out new coloured sea-shells before them! Thus they will be consoled; and you too, my friends, shall, like them, have your consolations – and new coloured sea-shells! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Rabble

LIFE is a fountain of delight; but where the rabble also drinks all wells are poisoned. I love all that is clean; but I do not like to see the grinning mouths and the thirst of the unclean. They cast their eyes down into the well: now their repulsive smile glitters up to me out of the well. They have poisoned the holy water with their lascivious-ness; and when they called their dirty dreams 'delight' they poisoned even the words, too. The flame is unwilling to burn when they put their damp hearts to the fire; the spirit itself bubbles and smokes when the rabble approaches the fire. The fruit grows mawkish and over-ripe in their hands: the fruit tree becomes unstable and withered at the top under their glance. And many a one who turned away from life, turned away only from the rabble: he did not wish to share the well and the flame and the fruit with the rabble. And many a one who went into the desert and suffered thirst with beasts of prey merely did not wish to sit around the cistern with dirty camel-drivers. And many a one who came along like a destroyer and a shower of hail to all orchards wanted merely to put his foot into the jaws of the rabble and so stop its throat. And to know that life itself has need of enmity and dying and martyrdoms, that was not the mouthful that choked me most. But I once asked, and my question almost stifled me: What, does life have need of the rabble, too? Are poisoned wells necessary, and stinking fires and dirty dreams and maggots in the bread of life? Not my hate but my disgust hungrily devoured my life! Alas, I often grew weary of the spirit when I found the rabble, too, had been gifted with spirit! And I turned my back upon the rulers when I saw what they now call ruling: bartering and haggling for power – with the rabble! I dwelt with stopped ears among peoples with a strange language: that the language of their bartering and their haggling for power might remain strange to me. And I went ill-humouredly through all yesterdays and todays holding my nose: truly, all yesterdays and todays smell badly of the scribbling rabble! Like a cripple who has gone blind, deaf, and dumb: thus have I lived for a long time, that I might not live with the power-rabble, the scribbling-rabble, and the pleasure-rabble. My spirit mounted steps wearily and warily; alms of delight were its refreshment; the blind man's life crept along on a staff. Yet what happened to me? How did I free myself from disgust? Who rejuvenated my eyes? How did I fly to the height where the rabble no longer sit at the well? Did my disgust itself create wings and water-divining powers for me? Truly, I

had to fly to the extremest height to find again the fountain of delight! Oh, I have found it, my brothers! Here, in the extremest height, the fountain of delight gushes up for me! And here there is a life at which no rabble drinks with me! You gush up almost too impetuously, fountain of delight! And in wanting to fill the cup, you often empty it again! And I still have to learn to approach you more discreetly: my heart still flows towards you all-too-impetuously. My heart, upon which my summer burns, a short, hot, melancholy, over-joyful summer: how my summer-heart longs for your coolness! Gone is the lingering affliction of my spring! Gone the malice of my snowflakes in June! Summer have I become entirely, and summer-noonday! A summer at the extremest height with cold fountains and blissful stillness: oh come, my friends, that the stillness may become more blissful yet! For this is our height and our home: we live too nobly and boldly 16 here for all unclean men and their thirsts. Only cast your pure eyes into the well of my delight, friends! You will not dim its sparkle! It shall laugh back at you with its purity. We build our nest in the tree Future; eagles shall bring food to us solitaries in their beaks! Truly, food in which no unclean men could join us! They would think they were eating fire and burn their mouths! Truly, we do not prepare a home here for unclean men! Their bodies and their spirits would call our happiness a cave of ice! So let us live above them like strong winds, neighbours of the eagles, neighbours of the snow, neighbours of the sun: that is how strong winds live. And like a wind will I one day blow among them and with my spirit take away the breath from their spirit: thus my future will have it. Truly, Zarathustra is a strong wind to all flatlands; and he offers this advice to his enemies and to all that spews and spits: ‘Take care not to spit against the wind!’ Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Tarantulas S EE, this is the tarantula’s cave! Do you want to see the tarantula itself? Here hangs its web: touch it and make it tremble. Here it comes docilely: Welcome, tarantula! Your triangle and symbol sit black upon your back; and I know too what sits within your soul. Revenge sits within your soul: a black scab grows wherever you bite; with revenge your poison makes the soul giddy! Thus do I speak to you in parables, you who make the soul giddy, you preachers of equality ! You are tarantulas and dealers in hidden revengefulness! But I will soon bring your hiding places to light: therefore I laugh my laughter of the heights in your faces. I pull at your web that your rage may lure you from your cave of lies and your revenge may bound forward from behind your word ‘justice’. For that man may be freed from the bonds of revenge : that is the bridge to my highest hope and a rainbow after protracted storms. But, naturally, the tarantulas would have it differently. ‘That the world may become full of the storms of our revenge, let precisely that be called justice by us’ – thus they talk together. ‘We shall practise revenge and outrage against all who are not as we are’ – thus the tarantula-hearts promise themselves. ‘And “will to equality” – that itself shall henceforth be the name of

virtue; and we shall raise outcry against everything that has power!’ You preachers of equality, thus from you the tyrant-madness of impotence cries for ‘equality’: thus your most secret tyrant-appetite disguises itself in words of virtue. Soured self-conceit, repressed envy, perhaps your fathers’ self-conceit and envy: they burst from you as a flame and madness of revenge. What the father kept silent the son speaks out; and I often found the son the father’s revealed secret. They resemble inspired men: but it is not the heart that inspires them – it is revenge. And when they become refined and cold, it is not their mind, it is their envy that makes them refined and cold. Their jealousy leads them upon thinkers’ paths too; and this is the mark of their jealousy – they always go too far: so that their weariness has at last to lie down and sleep even on the snow. Revenge rings in all their complaints, a malevolence is in all their praise; and to be judge seems bliss to them. Thus, however, I advise you, my friends: Mistrust all in whom the urge to punish is strong! They are people of a bad breed and a bad descent; the executioner and the bloodhound peer from out their faces. Mistrust all those who talk much about their justice! Truly, it is not only honey that their souls lack. And when they call themselves ‘the good and just’, do not forget that nothing is lacking to make them into Pharisees except – power! My friends, I do not want to be confused with others or taken for what I am not. There are those who preach my doctrine of life: yet are at the same time preachers of equality, and tarantulas. That they speak well of life, these poison spiders, although they sit in their caves and with their backs turned on life, is because they want to do harm by speaking well of life. They want to do harm to those who now possess power: for with those the preaching of death is still most at home. If it were otherwise, the tarantulas would teach otherwise: and it is precisely they who were formerly the best world-slanderers and heretic-burners. I do not want to be confused with these preachers of equality, nor taken for one of them. For justice speaks thus to me : ‘Men are not equal.’ And they should not become so, either! For what were my love of the Superman if I spoke otherwise? They should press on to the future across a thousand bridges and gangways, and there should be more and more war and inequality among them: thus my great love makes me speak! They should become devisers of emblems and phantoms in their enmity, and with their emblems and phantoms they should fight together the supreme fight! Good and evil, and rich and poor, and noble and mean, and all the names of the virtues: they should be weapons and ringing symbols that life must overcome itself again and again! Life wants to raise itself on high with pillars and steps; it wants to gaze into the far distance and out upon joyful splendour – that is why it needs height! And because it needs height, it needs steps and conflict between steps and those who climb them! Life wants to climb and in climbing overcome itself. And just look, my friends! Here, where the tarantula’s cave is, there rises up the ruins of an old temple – just look at it with

enlightened eyes! Truly, he who once towered up his thoughts in stone here knew as well as the wisest about the secret of all life! That there is battle and inequality and war for power and predominance even in beauty: he teaches us that here in the dearest parable. How divinely vault and arch here oppose one another in the struggle: how they strive against one another with light and shadow, these divinely-striving things. Beautiful and assured as these, let us also be enemies, my friends! Let us divinely strive against one another! Ha! Now the tarantula, my old enemy, has bitten me! Divinely beautiful and assured, it bit me in the finger! 'There must be punishment and justice' – thus it thinks: 'here he shall not sing in vain songs in honour of enmity!' Yes, the tarantula has revenged itself I And alas, now it will make my soul, too, giddy with revenge! But so that I may not veer round, tie me tight to this pillar, my friends! I would rather be even a pillar-saint than a whirlpool of revengefulness! Truly, Zarathustra is no veering wind nor whirlwind; and although he is a dancer, he is by no means a tarantella dancer! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Famous Philosophers Y OU have served the people and the people's superstitions, all you famous philosophers! – you have not served truth! And it is precisely for that reason that they paid you reverence. And for that reason too they endured your disbelief, because it was a joke and a bypath for the people. Thus the lord indulges his slaves and even enjoys their insolence. But he who is hated by the people as a wolf is by the dogs: he is the free spirit, the enemy of fetters, the non-worshipper, the dweller in forests. To hunt him from his hiding-place – the people always called that 'having a sense of right': they have always set their sharpest-toothed dogs upon him. 'For where the people are, truth is! Woe to him who seeks!' That is how it has been from the beginning. You sought to make the people justified in their reverence: that you called 'will to truth', you famous philosophers! And your heart always said to itself: 'I came from the people: God's voice, too, came to me from them.' You have always been obstinate and cunning, like the ass, as the people's advocate. And many a man of power who wanted to fare well with the people harnessed in front of his horses – a little ass, a famous philosopher. And now I should like you to throw the lion-skin right off yourselves, you famous philosophers! The spotted skin of the beast of prey and the matted hair of the inquirer, the seeker, the overcomer! Ah, for me to learn to believe in your 'genuineness' you would first have to break your will to venerate. Genuine – that is what I call him who goes into godforsaken deserts and has broken his venerating heart. In the yellow sand and burned by the sun, perhaps he blinks thirstily at the islands filled with springs where living creatures rest beneath shady trees. But his thirst does not persuade him to become like these comfortable creatures: for where there are oases there are also idols. Hungered, violent, solitary, godless: that is how the lion-will wants to be. Free from the happiness of serfs, redeemed from gods and worship, fearless and fearful, great

and solitary: that is how the will of the genuine man is. The genuine men, the free spirits, have always dwelt in the desert, as the lords of the desert; but in the towns dwell the well-fed famous philosophers – the draught animals. For they always, as asses, pull – the people’s cart! Not that I am wroth with them for that: however, they are still servants and beasts in harness, even when they glitter with golden gear. And they have often been good and praiseworthy servants. For thus speaks virtue: ‘If you must be a servant, then seek him whom you can serve best! ‘The spirit and the virtue of your lord should thrive because you are his servant: thus you yourself will thrive with your lord’s spirit and virtue!’ And in truth, you famous philosophers, you servants of the people, you yourselves have thrived with the spirit and virtue of the people – and the people have thrived through you! It is to your honour I say this! But you are still of the people even in your virtue, of the people with their purblind eyes – of the people who do not know what spirit is! Spirit is the life that itself strikes into life: through its own torment it increases its own knowledge – did you know that before? And this is the spirit’s happiness: to be anointed and by tears consecrated as a sacrificial beast – did you know that before? And the blindness of the blind man and his seeking and groping shall yet bear witness to the power of the sun into which he gazed – did you know that before? And the enlightened man shall learn to build with mountains! It is a small thing for the spirit to move mountains – did you know that before? You know only the sparks of the spirit: but you do not see the anvil which the spirit is, nor the ferocity of its hammer! In truth, you do not know the spirit’s pride! But even less could you endure the spirit’s modesty, if it should ever deign to speak! And you have never yet dared to cast your spirit into a pit of snow: you are not hot enough for that! Thus you do not know the rapture of its coldness, either. But you behave in all things in too familiar a way with the spirit; and you have often made of wisdom a poorhouse and hospital for bad poets. You are no eagles: so neither do you know the spirit’s joy in terror. And he who is not a bird shall not make his home above abysses. You are tepid: but all deep knowledge flows cold. The innermost wells of the spirit are ice-cold: a refreshment to hot hands and handlers. You stand there respectable and stiff and with a straight back, you famous philosophers! – no strong wind or will propels you. Have you never seen a sail faring over the sea, rounded and swelling and shuddering before the impetuosity of the wind? Like a sail, shuddering before the impetuosity of the spirit, my wisdom fares over the sea – my untamed wisdom! But you servants of the people, you famous philosophers – how could you fare with me? Thus spoke Zarathustra. The Night Song I T is night: now do all leaping fountains speak louder. And my soul too is a leaping fountain. It is night: only now do all songs of lovers awaken. And my soul too is the song of a lover. Something unquenched, unquenchable, is in me, that wants to speak out. A craving for love is in me, that itself speaks the language of love. Light am I: ah,

that I were night! But this is my solitude, that I am girded round with light. Ah, that I were dark and obscure! How I would suck at the breasts of light! And I should bless you, little sparkling stars and glowworms above! – and be happy in your gifts of light. But I live in my own light, I drink back into myself the flames that break from me. I do not know the joy of the receiver; and I have often dreamed that stealing must be more blessed than receiving. It is my poverty that my hand never rests from giving; it is my envy that I see expectant eyes and illumined nights of desire. Oh wretchedness of all givers! Oh eclipse of my sun! Oh craving for desire! Oh ravenous hunger in satiety! They take from me: but do I yet touch their souls? A gulf stands between giving and receiving; and the smallest gulf must be bridged at last. A hunger grows from out of my beauty: I should like to rob those to whom I give – thus do I hunger after wickedness. Withdrawing my hand when another hand already reaches out to it; hesitating, like the waterfall that hesitates even in its plunge – thus do I hunger after wickedness. Such vengeance does my abundance concoct: such spite wells from my solitude. My joy in giving died in giving, my virtue grew weary of itself through its abundance! The danger for him who always gives, is that he may lose his shame; the hand and heart of him who distributes grow callous through sheer distributing. My eye no longer overflows with the shame of suppliants; my hand has become too hard for the trembling of hands that have been filled. Where have the tears of my eye and the bloom of my heart gone? Oh solitude of all givers! Oh silence of all light-givers! Many suns circle in empty space: to all that is dark they speak with their light – to me they are silent. Oh, this is the enmity of light towards what gives light: unpitying it travels its way. Unjust towards the light-giver in its inmost heart, cold towards suns – thus travels every sun. Like a storm the suns fly along their courses; that is their travelling. They follow their inexorable will; that is their coldness. Oh, it is only you, obscure, dark ones, who extract warmth from light-givers! Oh, only you drink milk and comfort from the udders of light! Ah, ice is around me, my hand is burned with ice! Ah, thirst is in me, which yearns after your thirst! It is night: ah, that I must be light! And thirst for the things of night! And solitude! It is night: now my longing breaks from me like a well-spring – I long for speech. It is night: now do all leaping fountains speak louder. And my soul too is a leaping fountain. It is night: only now do all songs of lovers awaken. And my soul too is the song of a lover. Thus sang Zarathustra. The Dance Song O NE evening Zarathustra was walking through the forest with his disciples; and as he was looking for a well, behold, he came upon a green meadow quietly surrounded by trees and bushes: and in the meadow girls were dancing together. As soon as the girls recognized Zarathustra they ceased their dance; Zarathustra, however, approached them with a friendly air and spoke these words: Do not cease your dance, sweet girls! No spoil-sport has come to you with an evil eye, no enemy of girls. I am God's advocate with the Devil; he,

however, is the Spirit of Gravity. How could I be enemy to divine dancing, you nimble creatures? or to girls' feet with fair ankles? To be sure, I am a forest and a night of dark trees: but he who is not afraid of my darkness will find rosebowers too under my cypresses. And he will surely find too the little god whom girls love best: he lies beside the fountain, still, with his eyes closed. Truly, he has fallen asleep in broad daylight, the idler! Has he been chasing butterflies too much? Do not be angry with me, fair dancers, if I chastise the little god a little I. Perhaps he will cry out and weep, but he is laughable even in weeping! And with tears in his eyes, he shall ask you for a dance; and I myself will sing a song for his dance. A dance-song and a mocking-song on the Spirit of Gravity, my supreme, most powerful devil, who they say is 'the lord of the earth'. And this is the song Zarathustra sang as cupid and the girls danced together: Lately I looked into your eye, O Life! And I seemed to sink into the unfathomable. But you pulled me out with a golden rod; you laughed mockingly when I called you unfathomable. 'All fish talk like that,' you said; 'what they cannot fathom is unfathomable. 'But I am merely changeable and untamed and in everything a woman, and no virtuous one. 'Although you men call me "profound" or "faithful", "eternal", "mysterious". 'But you men always endow us with your own virtues – ah, you virtuous men!' Thus she laughed, the incredible woman; but I never believe her and her laughter when she speaks evil of herself. And when I spoke secretly with my wild Wisdom, she said to me angrily: 'You will, you desire, you love, that is the only reason you praise Life!' Then I almost answered crossly and told the truth to my angry Wisdom; and one cannot answer more crossly than when one 'tells the truth' to one's Wisdom. This then is the state of affairs between us three. From the heart of me I love only Life – and in truth, I love her most of all when I hate her! But that I am fond of Wisdom, and often too fond, is because she very much reminds me of Life! She has her eyes, her laughter, and even her little golden fishing-rod: how can I help it that they both look so alike? And when Life once asked me: 'Who is she then, this Wisdom?' – then I said eagerly: 'Ah yes! Wisdom! 'One thirsts for her and is not satisfied, one looks at her through veils, one snatches at her through nets. 'Is she fair? I know not! But the cleverest old fish are still lured by her. 'She is changeable and defiant; I have often seen her bite her lip and comb her hair against the grain. 'Perhaps she is wicked and false, and in everything a wench; but when she speaks ill of herself, then precisely is she most seductive.' When I said this to Life, she laughed maliciously and closed her eyes. 'But whom are you speaking of?' she asked, 'of me, surely? 'And if you are right – should you tell me that to my face? But now speak of your Wisdom, too!' Ah, and then you opened your eyes again, O beloved Life! And again I seemed to sink into the unfathomable. Thus sang Zarathustra. But when the dance had ended and the girls had gone away, he grew sad. The sun has long since set (he said at last); the

meadow is damp, coolness is coming from the forests. Something strange and unknown is about me, looking thoughtfully at me. What I are you still living, Zarathustra? Why? Wherefore? Whereby? Whither? Where? How? Is it not folly to go on living? Ah, my friends, it is the evening that questions thus within me.. Forgive me my sadness! Evening has come: forgive me that it has become evening! Thus spoke Zarathustra. The Funeral Song ‘Y ONDER is the grave-island, the silent island; yonder too are the graves of my youth. I will bear thither an evergreen wreath of life.’ Resolving thus in my heart I fared over the sea. O, you sights and visions of my youth! O, all you glances of love, you divine momentary glances! 17 How soon you perished! Today I think of you as my dead ones. A sweet odour comes to me from you, my dearest dead ones, a heart-easing odour that banishes tears. Truly, it moves and eases the solitary seafarer’s heart. Still am I the richest and most-to-be-envied man – I, the most solitary! For I had you and you have me still: tell me, to whom have such rosy apples fallen from the tree as have fallen to me? Still am I heir and heritage of your love, blooming to your memory with many-coloured wild-growing virtues, O my most beloved ones! Ah, we were made for one another, you gentle, strange marvels; and you came to me and my longing not as timid birds – no, you came trusting to me, who also trusted. Yes, made for faithfulness, like me, and for tender eternities: must I now name you by your unfaithfulness, you divine glances and moments: I have as yet learned no other name. Truly, you perished too soon, you fugitives. Yet you did not fly from me, nor did I fly from you: we are innocent towards one another in our unfaithfulness. They put you to death, you song-birds of my hopes, in order to kill me ! Yes, the arrows of malice were always directed at you, my beloved ones – in order to strike at my heart! And they struck! You were always my heart’s dearest, my possession and my being-possessed: therefore you had to die young and all-too-early! They shot the arrow at the most vulnerable thing I possessed: and that was you, whose skin is like down and even more like the smile that dies at a glance! But I will say this to my enemies: What is any manslaughter compared with what you did to me! You did a worse thing to me than any manslaughter; you took from me the irretrievable – thus I speak to you, my enemies! You murdered my youth’s visions and dearest marvels! You took from me my playfellows, those blessed spirits I To their memory do I lay this wreath and this curse. This curse upon you, my enemies! You have cut short my eternity, as a note is cut short in the cold night! It came to me hardly as the twinkling of divine eyes – as a moment! Thus in a happy hour my purity once spoke: ‘All creatures shall be divine to me.’ Then you surprised me with foul phantoms; alas, whither has that happy hour fled now? ‘All days shall be holy to me’ – thus the wisdom of my youth once spoke: truly, the speech of a joyful wisdom! But then you, my enemies, stole my nights from me and sold them to sleepless torment: alas, whither has that joyful wisdom fled now? Once I longed

for happy bird-auspices: then you led an owl-monster across my path, an adverse sign. Alas, whither did my tender longings flee then? I once vowed to renounce all disgust; then you transformed my kindred and neighbours into abscesses. Alas, whither did my noblest vow flee then? Once, as a blind man, I walked on happy paths; then you threw filth in the blind man's path: and now die old footpath disgusts him. And when I achieved my most difficult task and celebrated the victory of my overcomings: then you made those whom I loved cry out that I hurt them most. Truly, all that was your doing: you embittered my finest honey and the industry of my finest bees. You have always sent the most insolent beggars to my liberality; you have always crowded the incurably shameless around my pity. Thus you have wounded my virtues' faith. And when I brought my holiest thing as a sacrifice, straightway your 'piety' placed its fatter gifts beside it: so that my holiest thing choked in the smoke of your fat. And once I wanted to dance as I had never yet danced: I wanted to dance beyond all heavens. Then you lured away my favourite singer. And then he struck up a gruesome, gloomy melody: alas, he trumpeted into my ears like a mournful horn! Murderous singer, instrument of malice, most innocent man! I stood prepared for the finest dance: then you murdered my ecstasy with your tones! I know how to speak the parable of the highest things only in the dance – and now my greatest parable has remained in my limbs unspoken! My highest hope has remained unspoken and unachieved! And all the visions and consolations of my youth are dead! How did I endure it? How did I recover from such wounds, how did I overcome them? How did my soul arise again from these graves? Yes, something invulnerable, unburialable is within me, something that rends rocks: it is called my Will. Silently it steps and unchanging through the years. It shall go its course upon my feet, my old Will; hard of heart and invulnerable is its temper. I am invulnerable only in my heels. You live there and are always the same, most patient one! You will always break out of all graves! In you too still live on all the unachieved things of my youth; and you sit as life and youth, hopefully, here upon yellow grave-ruins. Yes, you are still my destroyer of all graves: Hail, my Will! And only where there are graves are there resurrections. Thus sang Zarathustra. Of Self-Overcoming W HAT urges you on and arouses your ardour, you wisest of men, do you call it 'will to truth'? Will to the conceivability of all being: that is what I call your will! You first want to make all being conceivable: for, with a healthy mistrust, you doubt whether it is in fact conceivable. But it must bend and accommodate itself to you! Thus will your will have it. It must become smooth and subject to the mind as the mind's mirror and reflection. That is your entire will, you wisest men; it is a will to power; and that is so even when you talk of good and evil and of the assessment of values. You want to create the world before which you can kneel: this is your ultimate hope and intoxication. The ignorant, to be sure, the people – they are like a river down which a boat

swims: and in the boat, solemn and disguised, sit the assessments of value. You put your will and your values upon the river of becoming; what the people believe to be good and evil betrays to me an ancient will to power. It was you, wisest men, who put such passengers in this boat and gave them splendour and proud names – you and your ruling will! Now the river bears your boat along: it has to bear it. It is of small account if the breaking wave foams and angrily opposes its keel! It is not the river that is your danger and the end of your good and evil, you wisest men, it is that will itself, the will to power, the unexhausted, procreating life-will. But that you may understand my teaching about good and evil, I shall relate to you my teaching about life and about the nature of all living creatures. I have followed the living creature, I have followed the greatest and the smallest paths, that I might understand its nature. I caught its glance in a hundredfold mirror when its mouth was closed, that its eye might speak to me. And its eye did speak to me. But wherever I found living creatures, there too I heard the language of obedience. All living creatures are obeying creatures. And this is the second thing: he who cannot obey himself will be commanded. That is the nature of living creatures. But this is the third thing I heard: that commanding is more difficult than obeying. And not only because the commander bears the burden of all who obey, and that this burden can easily crush him. In all commanding there appeared to me to be an experiment and a risk: and the living creature always risks himself when he commands. Yes, even when he commands himself: then also must he make amends for his commanding. He must become judge and avenger and victim of his own law. How has this come about? thus I asked myself. What persuades the living creature to obey and to command and to practise obedience even in commanding? Listen now to my teaching, you wisest men! Test in earnest whether I have crept into the heart of life itself and down to the roots of its heart! Where I found a living creature, there I found will to power; and even in the will of the servant I found the will to be master. The will of the weaker persuades it to serve the stronger; its will wants to be master over those weaker still: this delight alone it is unwilling to forgo. And as the lesser surrenders to the greater, that it may have delight and power over the least of all, so the greatest, too, surrenders and for the sake of power stakes – life. The devotion of the greatest is to encounter risk and danger and play dice for death. And where sacrifice and service and loving glances are, there too is will to be master. There the weaker steals by secret paths into the castle and even into the heart of the more powerful – and steals the power. And life itself told me this secret: ‘Behold,’ it said, ‘I am that which must overcome itself again and again ‘To be sure, you call it will to procreate or impulse towards a goal, towards the higher, more distant, more manifold: but all this is one and one secret. ‘I would rather perish than renounce this one thing; and truly, where there is perishing and the falling of leaves, behold, there life sacrifices itself – for the sake of power!’

‘That I have to be struggle and becoming and goal and conflict of goals: ah, he who divines my will surely divines, too, along what crooked paths it has to go! ‘Whatever I create and however much I love it – soon I have to oppose it and my love: thus will my will have it. ‘And you too, enlightened man, are only a path and footstep of my will: truly, my will to power walks with the feet of your will to truth! ‘He who shot the doctrine of “will to existence” at truth certainly did not hit the truth: this will – does not exist! ‘For what does not exist cannot will; but that which is in existence, how could it still want to come into existence? ‘Only where life is, there is also will: not will to life, but – so I teach you – will to power! ‘The living creature values many things higher than life itself; yet out of this evaluation itself speaks – the will to power!’ Thus life once taught me: and with this teaching do I solve the riddle of your hearts, you wisest men. Truly, I say to you: Unchanging good and evil does not exist! From out of themselves they must overcome themselves again and again. You exert power with your values and doctrines of good and evil, you assessors of values; and this is your hidden love and the glittering, trembling, and overflowing of your souls. But a mightier power and a new overcoming grow from out your values: egg and egg-shell break against them. And he who has to be a creator in good and evil, truly, has first to be a destroyer and break values. Thus the greatest evil belongs with the greatest good: this, however, is the creative good. Let us speak of this, you wisest men, even if it is a bad thing. To be silent is worse; all suppressed truths become poisonous. And let everything that can break upon our truths – break! There is many a house still to build! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Sublime Men S TILL is the bottom of my sea: who could guess that it hides sportive monsters! Imperturbable is my depth: but it glitters with swimming riddles and laughter. Today I saw a sublime man, a solemn man, a penitent of the spirit: oh, how my soul laughed at his ugliness! With upraised breast and in the attitude of a man drawing in breath: thus he stood there, the sublime man, and silent. Hung with ugly truths, the booty of his hunt, and rich in torn clothes; many thorns, too, hung on him – but I saw no rose. As yet he has not learned of laughter and beauty. This huntsman returned gloomily from the forest of knowledge. He returned home from the fight with wild beasts: but a wild beast still gazes out of his seriousness – a beast that has not been overcome! He stands there like a tiger about to spring; but I do not like these tense souls, my taste is hostile towards all these withdrawn men. And do you tell me, friends, that there is no dispute over taste and tasting? But all life is dispute over taste and tasting! Taste: that is at the same time weight and scales and weigher; and woe to all living creatures that want to live without dispute over weight and scales and weigher! If he grew weary of his sublimity, this sublime man, only then would his beauty rise up – and only then will I taste him and find him tasty. And only if he turns away from himself will he jump over his own shadow – and jump, in truth, into his own

sunlight. He has sat all too long in the shadows, the cheeks of the penitent of the spirit have grown pale; he has almost starved on his expectations. There is still contempt in his eye, and disgust lurks around his mouth. He rests now, to be sure, but he has never yet lain down in the sunlight. He should behave like the ox; and his happiness should smell of the earth and not of contempt for the earth. I should like to see him as a white ox, snorting and bellowing as he goes before the plough: and his bellowing, too, should laud all earthly things! His countenance is still dark; his hand's shadow plays upon it. The sense of his eyes, too, is overshadowed. His deed itself is still the shadow upon him: the hand darkens the doer. 18 He has still not overcome his deed. To be sure, I love in him the neck of the ox: but now I want to see the eye of the angel, too. He must unlearn his heroic will, too: he should be an exalted man and not only a sublime one – the ether itself should raise him up, the will-less one! He has tamed monsters, he has solved riddles: but he should also redeem his monsters and riddles, he should transform them into heavenly children. His knowledge has not yet learned to smile and to be without jealousy; his gushing passion has not yet grown calm in beauty. Truly, his longing should be silenced and immersed not in satiety but in beauty! The generosity of the magnanimous man should include gracefulness. With his arm laid across his head: that is how the hero should rest, that is also how he should overcome his rest. But it is precisely to the hero that beauty is the most difficult of all things. Beauty is unattainable to all violent wills. A little more, a little less: precisely that is much here, here that is the most of all. To stand with relaxed muscles and unharnessed wills: that is the most difficult thing for all of you, you sublime men! When power grows gracious and descends into the visible: I call such descending beauty. And I desire beauty from no one as much as I desire it from you, you man of power: may your goodness be your ultimate self-overpowering. I believe you capable of any evil: therefore I desire of you the good. In truth, I have often laughed at the weaklings who think themselves good because their claws are blunt! You should aspire to the virtue of the pillar: the higher it rises, the fairer and more graceful it grows, but inwardly harder and able to bear more weight. Yes, you sublime man, you too shall one day be fair and hold the mirror before your own beauty. Then your soul will shudder with divine desires; and there will be worship even in your vanity! This indeed is the secret of the soul: only when the hero has deserted the soul does there approach it in dreams – the superhero. Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Land of Culture I FLEW too far into the future: a horror assailed me. And when I looked around, behold! time was my only contemporary. Then I flew back, homeward – and faster and faster I flew: and so I came to you, you men of the present, and to the land of culture. The first time I brought with me an eye to see you and healthy desires: truly, I came to you with longing in my heart. But how did I fare? Although I was so afraid – I had to laugh! My eye had never seen

anything so motley-spotted! I laughed and laughed, while my foot still trembled and my heart as well: 'Here must be the home of all the paint-pots!' I said. Painted with fifty blotches on face and limbs: thus you sat there to my astonishment, you men of the present! And with fifty mirrors around you, flattering and repeating your opalescence! Truly, you could wear no better masks than your own faces, you men of the present! Who could – recognize you! Written over with the signs of the past and these signs over-daubed with new signs: thus you have hidden yourselves well from all interpreters of signs! And if one tests your virility, one finds only sterility! You seem to be baked from colours and scraps of paper glued together. All ages and all peoples gaze motley out of your veils; all customs and all beliefs speak motley out of your gestures. He who tore away from you your veils and wraps and paint and gestures would have just enough left over to frighten the birds. Truly, I myself am the frightened bird who once saw you naked and without paint; and I flew away when the skeleton made advances to me. I would rather be a day-labourer in the underworld and among the shades of the bygone! – Even the inhabitants of the underworld are fatter and fuller than you! This, yes this is bitterness to my stomach, that I can endure you neither naked nor clothed, you men of the present! And the unfamiliar things of the future, and whatever frightened stray birds, are truly more familiar and more genial than your 'reality'. For thus you speak: 'We are complete realists, and without belief or superstition': thus you thump your chests – alas, even without having chests! But how should you be able to believe, you motley-spotted men! – you who are paintings of all that has ever been believed! You are walking refutations of belief itself and the fracture of all thought. Unworthy of belief : that is what I call you, you realists! All ages babble in confusion in your spirits; and the dreaming and babbling of all ages was more real than is your waking! You are unfruitful: therefore you lack belief. But he who had to create always had his prophetic dreams and star-auguries -and he believed in belief! You are half-open doors at which grave-diggers wait. And this is your reality: 'Everything is worthy of perishing.' Ah, how you stand there, you unfruitful men, how lean-ribbed! And, indeed, many of you have noticed that. And they have said: 'Perhaps a god has secretly taken something from me there as I slept? Truly, sufficient to form a little woman for himself! 'Amazing is the poverty of my ribs!' That is how many a present-day man has spoken. Yes, you are laughable to me, you men of the present! And especially when you are amazed at yourselves! And woe to me if I could not laugh at your amazement and had to drink down all that is repulsive in your bowels. However, I will make light of you, since I have heavy things to carry; and what do I care if beetles and dragonflies sit themselves on my bundle! Truly, it shall not become heavier on that account! And the great weariness shall not come to me from you, you men of the present. Alas, whither shall I climb now with my longing? I look out from

every mountain for fatherlands and motherlands. But nowhere have I found a home; I am unsettled in every city and I depart from every gate. The men of the present, to whom my heart once drove me, are strange to me and a mockery; and I have been driven from fatherlands and motherlands. So now I love only my children's land, the undiscovered land in the furthest sea: I bid my sails seek it and seek it. I will make amends to my children for being the child of my fathers: and to all the future – for this present! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of Immaculate Perception W HEN the moon rose yesterday I thought it was about to give birth to a sun, it lay on the horizon so broad and pregnant. But it was a liar with its pregnancy; and I will sooner believe in the man in the moon than in the woman. To be sure, he is not much of a man, either, this timid night-reveller. Truly, he travels over the roofs with a bad conscience. For he is lustful and jealous, the monk in the moon, lustful for the earth and for all the joys of lovers. No, I do not like him, this tomcat on the roofs! All who slink around half-closed windows are repugnant to me! Piously and silently he walks along on star-carpet: but I do not like soft-stepping feet on which not even a spur jingles. Every honest man's step speaks out: but the cat steals along over the ground. Behold, the moon comes along catlike and without honesty. This parable I speak to you sentimental hypocrites, to you of 'pure knowledge'! I call you – lustful! You too love the earth and the earthly: I have divined you well! – but shame and bad conscience is in your love – you are like the moon! Your spirit has been persuaded to contempt of the earthly, but your entrails have not: these, however, are the strongest part of you! And now your spirit is ashamed that it must do the will of your entrails and follows by-ways and lying-ways to avoid its own shame. 'For me, the highest thing would be to gaze at life without desire and not, as a dog does, with tongue hanging out' – thus speaks your mendacious spirit to itself: 'To be happy in gazing, with benumbed will, without the grasping and greed of egotism – cold and ashen in body but with intoxicated moon-eyes! 'For me, the dearest thing would be to love the earth as the moon loves it, and to touch its beauty with the eyes alone' -thus the seduced one seduces himself. 'And let this be called by me immaculate perception of all things: that I desire nothing of things, except that I may lie down before them like a mirror with a hundred eyes.' Oh, you sentimental hypocrites, you lustful men! You lack innocence in desire: and therefore you now slander desiring! Truly, you do not love the earth as creators, begetters, men joyful at entering upon a new existence! Where is innocence? Where there is will to begetting. And for me, he who wants to create beyond himself has the purest will. Where is beauty? Where I have to will with all my will; where I want to love and perish, that an image may not remain merely an image. Loving and perishing: these have gone together from eternity. Will to love: that means to be willing to die, too. Thus I speak to you cowards! But now your emasculated leering wants to be called 'contemplation'! And that which lets

cowardly eyes touch it shall be christened 'beautiful'! Oh, you befoulers of noble names! But it shall be your curse, you immaculate men, you of pure knowledge, that you will never bring forth, even if you lie broad and pregnant on the horizon! Truly, you fill your mouths with noble words: and are we supposed to believe that your hearts are overflowing, you habitual liars? But my words are poor, despised, halting words: I am glad to take what falls from the table at your feast. Yet with them I can still – tell the truth to hypocrites! Yes, my fish-bones, shells, and prickly leaves shall – tickle hypocrites' noses! There is always bad air around you and around your feasts: for your lustful thoughts, your lies and secrets are in the air! Only dare to believe in yourselves – in yourselves and in your entrails! He who does not believe in himself always lies. You have put on the mask of a god, you 'pure': your dreadful coiling snake has crawled into the mask of a god. Truly, you are deceivers, you 'contemplative'! Even Zarathustra was once the fool of your divine veneer; he did not guess at the serpent-coil with which it was filled. Once I thought I saw a god's soul at play in your play, you of pure knowledge! Once I thought there was no better art than your arts! Distance concealed from me the serpent-filth, and the evil odour, and that a lizard's cunning was prowling lustfully around. But I approached you: then day dawned for me – and now it dawns for you – the moon's love affair had come to an end! Just look! There it stands, pale and detected – before the dawn! For already it is coming, the glowing sun – its love of the earth is coming! All sun-love is innocence and creative desire! Just look how it comes impatiently over the sea! Do you not feel the thirst and the hot breath of its love? It wants to suck at the sea and drink the sea's depths up to its height: now the sea's desire rises with a thousand breasts. It wants to be kissed and sucked by the sun's thirst; it wants to become air and height and light's footpath and light itself! Truly, like the sun do I love life and all deep seas. And this I call knowledge: all that is deep shall rise up – to my height! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of Scholars A S I lay asleep, a sheep ate at the ivy-wreath upon my head – ate and said: 'Zarathustra is no longer a scholar.' It spoke and went away stiffly and proud. A child told me of it. I like to lie here where children play, beside the broken wall, among thistles and red poppies. To children I am still a scholar, and to thistles and red poppies, too. They are innocent, even in their wickedness. But to the sheep I am no longer a scholar: thus my fate will have it – blessed be my fate! For this is the truth: I have left the house of scholars and slammed the door behind me. Too long did my soul sit hungry at their table; I have not been schooled, as they have, to crack knowledge as one cracks nuts. I love freedom and the air over fresh soil; I would sleep on ox-skins rather than on their dignities and respectabilities. I am too hot and scorched by my own thought: it is often about to take my breath away. Then I have to get into the open air and away from all dusty rooms. But they sit cool in the cool shade: they want to be mere spectators in everything and they take care

not to sit where the sun burns upon the steps. Like those who stand in the street and stare at the people passing by, so they too wait and stare at thoughts that others have thought. If one takes hold of them, they involuntarily raise a dust like sacks of flour; but who could guess that their dust derived from corn and from the golden joy of summer fields? When they give themselves out as wise, their little sayings and truths make me shiver: their wisdom often smells as if it came from the swamp: and indeed, I have heard the frog croak in it! They are clever, they have cunning fingers: what is my simplicity compared with their diversity? Their fingers understand all threading and knitting and weaving: thus they weave the stockings of the spirit! They are excellent clocks: only be careful to wind them up properly! Then they tell the hour without error and make a modest noise in doing so. They work like mills and rammers: just throw seed-corn into them! – they know how to grind corn small and make white dust of it. They keep a sharp eye upon one another and do not trust one another as well as they might. Inventive in small slynesses, they lie in wait for those whose wills go upon lame feet – they lie in wait like spiders. I have seen how carefully they prepare their poisons; they always put on protective gloves. They also know how to play with loaded dice; and I found them playing so zealously that they were sweating. We are strangers to one another, and their virtues are even more opposed to my taste than are their falsehoods and loaded dice. And when I lived among them I lived above them. They grew angry with me for that. They did not want to know that someone was walking over their heads; and so they put wood and dirt and rubbish between their heads and me. Thus they muffled the sound of my steps: and from then on the most scholarly heard me the worst. They put all the faults and weaknesses of mankind between themselves and me – they call this a ‘false flooring’ in their houses. But I walk above their heads with my thoughts in spite of that; and even if I should walk upon my own faults, I should still be above them and their heads. For men are not equal: thus speaks justice. And what I desire they may not desire! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of Poets ‘S INCE I have known the body better,’ said Zarathustra to one of his disciples, ‘the spirit has been only figuratively spirit to me; and all that is “intransitory” – that too has been only an “image”’. 19 ‘I heard you say that once before,’ answered the disciple; ‘and then you added: “But the poets lie too much.” Why did you say that the poets lie too much?’ ‘Why?’ said Zarathustra. ‘You ask why? I am not one of those who may be questioned about their Why. ‘Do my experiences date from yesterday? It is a long time since I experienced the reasons for my opinions. ‘Should I not have to be a barrel of memory, if I wanted to carry my reasons, too, about with me? ‘It is already too much for me to retain even my opinions; and many a bird has flown away. ‘And now and then I find in my dove-cote an immigrant creature which is strange to me and which trembles when I lay my hand upon it. ‘Yet what did Zarathustra once say to you? That the poets lie too

much? – But Zarathustra too is a poet. ‘Do you now believe that he spoke the truth? Why do you believe it?’ The disciple answered: ‘I believe in Zarathustra.’ But Zarathustra shook his head and smiled. Belief does not make me blessed (he said), least of all belief in myself. But granted that someone has said in all seriousness that the poets lie too much: he is right – we do lie too much. We know too little and are bad learners: so we have to lie. And which of us poets has not adulterated his wine? Many a poisonous hotch-potch has been produced in our cellars, many an indescribable thing has been done there. And because we know little, the poor in spirit delight our hearts, especially when they are young women. And we desire even those things the old women tell one another in the evening. We call that the eternal-womanly in us. And we believe in the people and its ‘wisdom’ as if there were a special secret entrance to knowledge which is blocked to him who has learned anything. But all poets believe this: that he who, lying in the grass or in lonely bowers, pricks up his ears, catches a little of the things that are between heaven and earth. And if they experience tender emotions, the poets always think that nature herself is in love with them: And that she creeps up to their ears, to speak secrets and amorous flattering words into them: of this they boast and pride themselves before all mortals! Alas, there are so many things between heaven and earth of which only the poets have let themselves dream! And especially above heaven: for all gods are poets’ images, poets’ surreptitiousness! Truly, it draws us ever upward – that is, to cloudland: we set our motley puppets on the clouds and then call them gods and supermen. And are they not light enough for these insubstantial seats? – all these gods and supermen. Alas, how weary I am of all the unattainable that is supposed to be reality. Alas, how weary I am of the poets! When Zarathustra had spoken thus, his disciple was angry with him, but kept silent. And Zarathustra, too, kept silent; and his eye had turned within him as if it were gazing into the far distance. At length he sighed and drew a breath. I am of today and of the has-been (he said then); but there is something in me that is of tomorrow and of the day-after-tomorrow and of the shall-be. I have grown weary of the poets, the old and the new: they all seem to me superficial and shallow seas. They have not thought deeply enough: therefore their feeling – has not plumbed the depths. A little voluptuousness and a little tedium: that is all their best ideas have ever amounted to. All their harp-jangling is to me so much coughing and puffing of phantoms; what have they ever known of the ardour of tones! They are not clean enough for me, either: they all disturb their waters so that they may seem deep. And in that way they would like to show themselves reconcilers: but to me they remain mediators and meddlers, and mediocre and unclean men! Ah, indeed I cast my net into their sea and hoped to catch fine fish; but I always drew out an old god’s head. Thus the sea gave a stone to the hungry man. And they themselves may well originate from the sea. To be sure, one finds pearls in them: then they

themselves are all the more like hard shell-fish. And instead of the soul I often found in them salty slime. They learned vanity, too, from the sea: is the sea not the peacock of peacocks? It unfurls its tail even before the ugliest of buffaloes, it never wearies of its lace-fan of silver and satin. The buffalo looks on insolently, his soul like the sand, yet more like the thicket, but most like the swamp. What are beauty and sea and peacock-ornaments to him? I speak this parable to the poets. Truly, their spirit itself is the peacock of peacocks and a sea of vanity! The poet's spirit wants spectators, even if they are only buffaloes! But I have grown weary of this spirit: and I see the day coming when it will grow weary of itself. Already I have seen the poets transformed; I have seen them direct their glance upon themselves. I have seen penitents of the spirit appearing; they grew out of the poets. Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of Great Events T HERE is an island in the sea – not far from the Blissful Islands of Zarathustra – upon which a volcano continually smokes; the people, and especially the old women among the people, say that it is placed like a block of stone before the gate of the underworld, but that the narrow downward path which leads to this gate of the underworld passes through the volcano itself. Now at the time Zarathustra was living on the Blissful Islands it happened that a ship dropped anchor at the island upon which the smoking mountain stood; and its crew landed in order to shoot rabbits. Towards the hour of noon, however, when the captain and his men were reassembled, they suddenly saw a man coming towards them through the air, and a voice said clearly: 'It is time! It is high time!' But as the figure was closest to them – it flew quickly past, however, like a shadow, in the direction of the volcano – they recognized, with the greatest consternation, that it was Zarathustra; for all of them had seen him before, except the captain himself, and they loved him as the people love: that is, with love and awe in equal parts. 'Just look!' said the old steersman, 'there is Zarathustra going to Hell!' At the same time as these sailors landed on the volcano island, the rumour went around that Zarathustra had disappeared; and when his friends were questioned, they said that he had gone aboard a ship by night without saying where he intended to sail. Thus there arose a disquiet; after three days, however, there was added to this disquiet the story of the sailors – and then all the people said that the Devil had carried Zarathustra off. Of course, his disciples laughed at this talk; and one of them even said: 'I would rather believe that Zarathustra had carried off the Devil.' But at the bottom of their souls they were all full of apprehension and longing: so great was their joy when, on the fifth day, Zarathustra appeared among them. And this is the tale of Zarathustra's conversation with the fire-dog: The earth (he said) has a skin; and this skin has diseases. One of these diseases, for example, is called 'Man'. And another of these diseases is called 'the fire-dog': men have told many lies and been told many lies about him. To fathom this secret I fared across the sea: and I have seen truth naked, truly! barefoot to the neck. Now I know all about the

fire-dog; and also about all the revolutionary and subversive devils which not only old women fear. ‘Up with you, fire-dog, up from your depth!’ I cried, ‘and confess how deep that depth is! Where does it come from, that which you snort up? ‘You drink deeply from the sea: your bitter eloquence betrays that! Truly, for a dog of the depths you take your food too much from the surface! ‘At the best, I hold you to be the earth’s ventriloquist: and when I have heard subversive and revolutionary devils speak, I have always found them like you: bitter, lying, and superficial. ‘You understand how to bellow and how to darken the air with ashes! You are the greatest braggart and have sufficiently learned the art of making mud boil. ‘Where you are there must always be mud around and much that is spongy, hollow, and compressed: it wants to be freed. “Freedom”, you all most like to bellow: but I have unlearned belief in “great events” whenever there is much bellowing and smoke about them. ‘And believe me, friend Infernal-racket! The greatest events – they are not our noisiest but our stillest hours. ‘The world revolves, not around the inventors of new noises, but around the inventors of new values; it revolves inaudibly. ‘And just confess! Little was ever found to have happened when your noise and smoke dispersed. What did it matter that a town had been mummified and a statue lay in the mud! ‘And I say this to the overthrowers of statues: To throw salt into the sea and statues into the mud are perhaps the greatest of follies. ‘The statue lay in the mud of your contempt: but this precisely is its law, that its life and living beauty grow again out of contempt! ‘And now it arises again, with diviner features and sorrowfully-seductive; and in truth! it will even thank you for overthrowing it, you overthrowers! ‘I tender, however, this advice to kings and churches and to all that is weak with age and virtue – only let yourselves be overthrown! That you may return to life, and that virtue – may return to you!’ Thus I spoke before the fire-dog: then he interrupted me sullenly and asked: ‘The church? What is that then?’ ‘The church?’ I answered. ‘The church is kind of state, and indeed the most mendacious kind. But keep quiet, you hypocrite dog! You surely know your own kind best! ‘Like you, the state is a hypocrite dog; like you, it likes to speak with smoke and bellowing – to make believe, like you, that it speaks out of the belly of things. ‘For the state wants to be absolutely the most important beast on earth; and it is believed to be so, too!’ When I said that, the fire-dog acted as if he were mad with envy. ‘What?’ he cried, ‘the most important beast on earth? And it is believed to be so, too?’ And so much steam and hideous shrieking came from his throat I thought he would choke with vexation and envy. At length he grew quieter and his panting ceased; as soon as he was quiet, however, I said laughing; ‘You are vexed, fire-dog: therefore I am right about you! ‘And that I may press my point, let me speak of another fire-dog, which really speaks from the heart of the earth. ‘His breath exhales gold and golden rain: so his heart will have it. What are ashes and smoke and hot mud to him now! ‘Laughter flutters from him

like a motley cloud; he is ill-disposed towards your gurgling and spitting and griping of the bowels! 'Gold and laughter, however, he takes from the heart of the earth: for, that you may know it – the heart of the earth is of gold . ' When the fire-dog heard this he could no longer bear to listen to me. Abashed, he drew in his tail, said 'Bow-wow' in a small voice and crawled down into his cave. Thus narrated Zarathustra. But his disciples hardly listened to him, so great was their desire to tell him about the sailors, the rabbits, and the flying man. 'What am I to think of it?' said Zarathustra. 'Am I then a ghost? 'But it will have been my shadow. Surely you have heard something of the Wanderer and his Shadow? 20 'This, however, is certain: I must keep it under stricter control – otherwise it will ruin my reputation.' And once again Zarathustra shook his head and wondered. 'What am I to think of it?' he said again. 'Why, then, did the phantom cry: "It is time! It is high time!"? ' For what, then, is it – high time?' Thus spoke Zarathustra. The Prophet –AND I saw a great sadness come over mankind. The best grew weary of their works. A teaching went forth, a belief ran beside it: Everything is empty, everything is one, everything is past! And from every hill it resounded: Everything is empty, everything is one, everything is past! We have harvested, it is true: but why did all our fruits turn rotten and brown? What fell from the wicked moon last night? All our work has been in vain, our wine has become poison, an evil eye has scorched our fields and our hearts. We have all become dry; and if fire fell upon us we should scatter like ashes – yes, we have made weary fire itself. All our wells have dried up, even the sea has receded. The earth wants to break open, but the depths will not devour us! Alas, where is there still a sea in which one could drown: thus our lament resounds – across shallow swamps. Truly, we have grown too weary even to die; now we are still awake and we live on – in sepulchres!' Thus did Zarathustra hear a prophet speak; 21 and his prophecy went to Zarathustra's heart and transformed him. He went about sad and weary; and he became like those of whom the prophet had spoken. 'Truly,' he said to his disciples, 'this long twilight is very nearly upon us. Alas, how shall I preserve my light through it? 'May it not be smothered in this sadness! It is meant to be a light to more distant worlds and to the most distant nights!' Zarathustra went about grieving thus in his heart; and for three days he took no food or drink, had no rest and forgot speech. At length it happened that he fell into a deep sleep. And his disciples sat around him in the long watches of the night and waited anxiously to see if he would awaken and speak again and be cured of his affliction. And this is the discourse that Zarathustra spoke when he awoke; his voice, however, came to his disciples as if from a great distance: Listen to the dream which I dreamed, friends, and help me to read its meaning! It is still a riddle to me, this dream; its meaning is hidden within it and imprisoned and does not yet fly above it with unconfined wings. I dreamed I had renounced all life. I had become a night-watchman and grave-watchman yonder upon the

lonely hill-fortress of death. Up there I guarded death's coffins: the musty vaults stood full of these symbols of death's victory. Life overcome regarded me from glass coffins. I breathed the odour of dust-covered eternities: my soul lay sultry and dust-covered. And who could have ventilated his soul there? Brightness of midnight was all around me, solitude crouched beside it; and, as a third, the rasping silence of death, the worst of my companions. I carried keys, the rustiest of all keys; and I could open with them the most creaking of all doors. When the wings of this door were opened, the sound ran through the long corridors like an evil croaking; this bird cried out ill-temperedly, it did not want to be awakened. But it was even more fearful and heart-tightening when it again became silent and still all around and I sat alone in that malignant silence. So did time pass with me and creep past, if time still existed: what did I know of it I But at last occurred that which awakened me. Three blows were struck on the door like thunderbolts, the vault resounded and roared three times again: then I went to the door. Alpa! I cried, who is bearing his ashes to the mountain? Alpa! Alpa! Who is bearing his ashes to the mountain? And I turned the key and tugged at the door and exerted myself. But it did not open by so much as a finger's breadth: Then a raging wind tore the door asunder: whistling, shrilling and piercing it threw to me a black coffin: And in the roaring and whistling and shrilling, the coffin burst asunder and vomited forth a thousand peals of laughter. And from a thousand masks of children, angels, owls, fools, and child-sized butterflies it laughed and mocked and roared at me. This terrified me dreadfully: it prostrated me. And I shrieked with horror as I had never shrieked before. But my own shrieking awoke me – and I came to myself. Thus Zarathustra narrated his dream and then fell silent: for he did not yet know the interpretation of his dream. But the disciple whom he loved most arose quickly, grasped Zarathustra's hand, and said: Your life itself interprets to us this dream, O Zarathustra! Are you yourself not the wind with a shrill whistling that tears open the doors of the fortress of death? Are you yourself not the coffin full of motley wickednesses and angel-masks of life? Truly, Zarathustra comes into all sepulchres like a thousand peals of children's laughter, laughing at these night-watchmen and grave-watchmen, and whoever else rattles gloomy keys. You will terrify and overthrow them with your laughter; fainting and reawakening will demonstrate your power over them. And even when the long twilight and the weariness unto death appears, you will not set in our heaven, you advocate of life! You have shown us new stars and new glories of the night; truly, you have spread out laughter itself above us like a motley canopy. Henceforth laughter of children will always issue from coffins; henceforth a strong wind will always come, victorious, to all weariness unto death: of that you yourself are our guarantee and prophet! Truly, you have dreamed your enemies themselves : that was your most oppressive dream! But as you awoke from them and came to yourself, so shall they awake from themselves

– and come to you! Thus spoke the disciple; and all the others then pressed around Zarathustra and grasped his hands and sought to persuade him to leave his bed and his sadness and return to them. But Zarathustra sat upon his bed erect and with an absent expression. Like one who has returned home after being long in a strange land did he look upon his disciples and examine their faces; and as yet he did not recognize them. But when they raised him and set him upon his feet, behold, his eye was suddenly transformed; he understood everything that had happened, stroked his beard, and said in a firm voice: Well now! This has had its time; but see to it, my disciples, that we have a good meal, and quickly! Thus I mean to do penance for bad dreams! The prophet, however, shall eat and drink beside me: and truly, I will yet show him a sea in which he can drown! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Then, however, he gazed long into the face of the disciple who had interpreted the dream, and shook his head. Of Redemption As Zarathustra was going across the great bridge one day, the cripples and beggars surrounded him and a hunchback spoke to him thus: Behold, Zarathustra! The people, too, learn from you and acquire belief in your teaching; but for the people to believe you completely, one thing is still needed – you must first convince even us cripples! Here now you have a fine selection and truly, an opportunity with more than one forelock! You can cure the blind and make the lame walk; and from him who has too much behind him you could well take a little away, too – that, I think, would be the right way to make the cripples believe in Zarathustra! But Zarathustra replied thus to him who had spoken: If one takes the hump away from the hunchback, one takes away his spirit – that is what the people teach. And if one gives eyes to the blind man, he sees too many bad things on earth: so that he curses him who cured him. But he who makes the lame man walk does him the greatest harm: for no sooner can he walk than his vices run away with him – that is what the people teach about cripples. And why should Zarathustra not learn from the people, if the people learn from Zarathustra? But it is the least serious thing to me, since I have been among men, to see that this one lacks an eye and that one an ear and a third lacks a leg, and there are others who have lost their tongue or their nose or their head. I see and have seen worse things and many of them so monstrous that I should not wish to speak of all of them; but of some of them I should not wish to be silent: and they are, men who lack everything except one thing, of which they have too much – men who are no more than a great eye or a great mouth or a great belly or something else great – I call such men inverse cripples. And when I emerged from my solitude and crossed over this bridge for the first time, I did not believe my eyes and looked and looked again and said at last: ‘That is an ear! An ear as big as a man!’ I looked yet more closely: and in fact under the ear there moved something that was pitifully small and meagre and slender. And in truth, the monstrous ear sat upon a little, thin stalk – the stalk, however, was a man! By the

use of a magnifying glass one could even discern a little, envious face as well; and one could discern, too, that a turgid little soul was dangling from the stalk. The people told me, however, that the great ear was not merely a man, but a great man, a genius. But I have never believed the people when they talked about great men – and I held to my belief that it was an inverse cripple, who had too little of everything and too much of one thing. When Zarathustra had spoken thus to the hunchback and to those whose mouthpiece and advocate he was, he turned to his disciples with profound ill-humour and said: Truly, my friends, I walk among men as among the fragments and limbs of men! The terrible thing to my eye is to find men shattered in pieces and scattered as if over a battle-field of slaughter. And when my eye flees from the present to the past, it always discovers the same thing: fragments and limbs and dreadful chances – but no men! The present and the past upon the earth – alas! my friends – that is my most intolerable burden; and I should not know how to live, if I were not a seer of that which must come. A seer, a wilier, a creator, a future itself and a bridge to the future – and alas, also like a cripple upon this bridge: Zarathustra is all this. And even you have often asked yourselves: Who is Zarathustra to us? What shall we call him? and, like me, you answer your own questions with questions. Is he a promiser? Or a fulfiller? A conqueror? Or an inheritor? A harvest? Or a ploughshare? A physician? Or a convalescent? Is he a poet? Or a genuine man? A liberator? Or a subduer? A good man? Or an evil man? I walk among men as among fragments of the future: of that future which I scan. And it is all my art and aim, to compose into one and bring together what is fragment and riddle and dreadful chance. And how could I endure to be a man, if man were not also poet and reader of riddles and the redeemer of chance! To redeem the past and to transform every ‘It was’ into an ‘I wanted it thus!’ – that alone do I call redemption! Will – that is what the liberator and bringer of joy is called: thus I have taught you, my friends! But now learn this as well: The will itself is still a prisoner. Willing liberates: but what is it that fastens in fetters even the liberator? ‘It was’: that is what the will’s teeth-gnashing and most lonely affliction is called. Powerless against that which has been done, the will is an angry spectator of all things past. The will cannot will backwards; that it cannot break time and time’s desire – that is the will’s most lonely affliction. Willing liberates: what does willing itself devise to free itself from its affliction and to mock at its dungeon? Alas, every prisoner becomes a fool! The imprisoned will, too, releases itself in a foolish way. It is sullenly wrathful that time does not run back; ‘That which was’ – that is what the stone which it cannot roll away is called. And so, out of wrath and ill-temper, the will rolls stones about and takes revenge upon him who does not, like it, feel wrath and ill-temper. Thus the will, the liberator, becomes a malefactor: and upon all that can suffer it takes revenge for its inability to go backwards. This, yes, this alone is revenge itself: the will’s antipathy towards time and time’s ‘It was’.

Truly, a great foolishness dwells in our will; and that this foolishness acquired spirit has become a curse to all human kind. The spirit of revenge : my friends, that, up to now, has been mankind's chief concern; and where there was suffering, there was always supposed to be punishment. 'Punishment' is what revenge calls itself: it feigns a good conscience for itself with a lie. And because there is suffering in the willer himself, since he cannot will backwards – therefore willing itself and all life was supposed to be – punishment! And then cloud upon cloud rolled over the spirit: until at last madness preached: 'Everything passes away, therefore everything deserves to pass away! 'And that law of time, that time must devour her children, is justice itself: thus madness preached. 'Things are ordered morally according to justice and punishment. Oh, where is redemption from the stream of things and from the punishment "existence"? ' Thus madness preached. 'Can there be redemption when there is eternal justice? Alas, the stone "It was" cannot be rolled away: all punishments, too, must be eternal!' Thus madness preached. 'No deed can be annihilated: how could a deed be undone through punishment? That existence too must be an eternally-recurring deed and guilt, this, this is what is eternal in the punishment "existence"! 'Except the will at last redeem itself and willing become not-willing –': but you, my brothers, know this fable-song of madness! I led you away from these fable-songs when I taught you: 'The will is a creator.' All 'It was' is a fragment, a riddle, a dreadful chance – until the creative will says to it: 'But I willed it thus!' Until the creative will says to it: 'But I will it thus! Thus shall I will it!' But has it ever spoken thus? And when will this take place? Has the will yet been unharnessed from its own folly? Has the will become its own redeemer and bringer of joy? Has it unlearned the spirit of revenge and all teeth-gnashing? And who has taught it to be reconciled with time, and higher things than reconciliation? The will that is the will to power must will something higher than any reconciliation – but how shall that happen? Who has taught it to will backwards, too? But at this point of his discourse, Zarathustra suddenly broke off and looked exactly like a man seized by extremest terror. With terrified eyes he gazed upon his disciples; his eyes transpierced their thoughts and their reservations 22 as if with arrows. But after a short time he laughed again and said in a soothed voice: 'It is difficult to live among men because keeping silent is so difficult. Especially for a babblers.' Thus spoke Zarathustra. The hunchback, however, had listened to the conversation and had covered his face the while; but when he heard Zarathustra laugh, he looked up in curiosity, and said slowly: 'But why does Zarathustra speak to us differently than to his disciples?' Zarathustra answered: 'What is surprising in that? One may well speak in a hunchbacked manner to a hunchback!' 23 'Very good,' said the hunchback; 'and with pupils one may well tell tales out of school. 'But why does Zarathustra speak to his pupils differently – than to himself?' Of Manly Prudence I T is not the height, it

is the abyss that is terrible! The abyss where the glance plunges downward and the hand grasps upward . There the heart grows giddy through its twofold will. Ah, friends, have you, too, divined my heart's twofold will? That my glance plunges into the heights and that my hand wants to hold on to the depths and lean there – that, that is my abyss and my danger. My will clings to mankind, I bind myself to mankind with fetters, because I am drawn up to the Superman: for my other will wants to draw me up to the Superman. That my hand may not quite lose its belief in firmness: that is why I live blindly among men, as if I did not recognize them. I do not recognize you men: this darkness and consolation has often spread around me. I sit at the gateway and wait for every rogue and ask: Who wants to deceive me? This is my first manly prudence: I let myself be deceived so as not to be on guard against deceivers. Ah, if I were on guard against men, how could men be an anchor for my ball? It would be torn upward and away too easily! This providence lies over my fate: I have to be without foresight. And he who does not want to die of thirst among men must learn to drink out of all glasses; and he who wants to stay clean among men must know how to wash himself even with dirty water. And to console myself I often spoke thus: 'Well then! Come on, old heart! A misfortune failed to harm you: enjoy that as your – good fortune!' This, however, is my second manly prudence: I am more considerate to the vain than to the proud. Is wounded vanity not the mother of all tragedies? But where pride is wounded there surely grows up something better than pride. If life is to be pleasant to watch, its play must be well acted: for that, however, good actors are needed. I found all vain people to be good actors: they act and desire that others shall want to watch them – all their spirit is in this desire. They act themselves, they invent themselves; I like to watch life in their vicinity – it cures melancholy. I am considerate to the vain because they are physicians to my melancholy and hold me fast to mankind as to a play. And further: who can estimate the full depth of the vain man's modesty! I love and pity him on account of his modesty. He wants to learn belief in himself from you; he feeds upon your glances, he eats praise out of your hands. He believes even your lies when you lie favourably to him: for his heart sighs in its depths: 'What am I ?' And if the virtue that is unconscious of itself be the true virtue: well, the vain man is unconscious of his modesty! This, however, is my third manly prudence: I do not let your timorousness spoil my pleasure at the sight of the wicked. I am happy to see the marvels the hot sun hatches: tigers and palm trees and rattle-snakes. Among men, too, there is a fine brood of the hot sun and much that is marvellous in the wicked. Indeed, as your wisest man did not seem so very wise to me, so I found that human wickedness, too, did not live up to its reputation. And I often shook my head and asked: Why go on rattling, you rattle-snakes? Truly, there is still a future, even for evil! And the hottest South has not yet been discovered for mankind. How many a thing is now called grossest

wickedness which is only twelve feet broad and three months long! One day, however, greater dragons will come into the world. For, that the Superman may not lack his dragon, the super-dragon worthy of him, much hot sunshine must yet burn upon damp primeval forests! Your wild cats must have become tigers and your poison-toads crocodiles: for the good huntsman shall have a good hunt! And truly, you good and just! There is much in you that is laughable and especially your fear of him who was formerly called the 'Devil'! Your souls are so unfamiliar with what is great that the Superman would be fearful to you in his goodness! And you wise and enlightened men, you would flee from the burning sun of wisdom in which the Superman joyfully bathes his nakedness! You highest men my eyes have encountered! This is my doubt of you and my secret laughter: I think you would call my Superman – a devil! Alas, I grew weary of these highest and best men: from their 'heights' I longed to go up, out, away to the Superman! A horror overcame me when I saw these best men naked: then there grew for me the wings to soar away into distant futures. Into most distant futures, into more southerly Souths than artist ever dreamed of: thither where gods are ashamed of all clothes! But I want to see you disguised, you neighbours and fellow-men, and well-dressed and vain and worthy as 'the good and just'. And I myself will sit among you disguised, so that I may misunderstand you and myself: that, in fact, is my last manly prudence. Thus spoke Zarathustra. The stillest hour W HAT has happened to me, my friends? You behold me troubled, driven forth, unwillingly obedient, ready to go – alas, to go away from you! Yes, Zarathustra must go into his solitude once again: but this time the bear goes unhappily back into his cave! What has happened to me? Who has ordered this? – alas, my mistress will have it so, so she told me; have I ever told you her name? Yesterday towards evening my stillest hour spoke to me: that is the name of my terrible mistress. And thus it happened, for I must tell you everything, that your hearts may not harden against me for departing so suddenly! Do you know the terror which assails him who is falling asleep? He is terrified down to his toes, because the ground seems to give way, and the dream begins. I tell you this in a parable. Yesterday, at the stillest hour, the ground seemed to give way: my dream began. The hand moved, the dock of my life held its breath – I had never heard such stillness about me: so that my heart was terrified. Then, voicelessly, something said to me: 'You know, Zarathustra?' And I cried out for terror at this whisper, and the blood drained from my face: but I kept silent. Then again, something said to me voicelessly: 'You know, Zarathustra, but you do not speak!' And I answered at last defiantly: 'Yes, I know, but I will not speak!' Then again something said to me voicelessly: 'You will not, Zarathustra? Is this true? Do not hide yourself in your defiance!' And I wept and trembled like a child and said: 'Alas, I want to, but how can I? Release me from this alone! It is beyond my strength!' Then again something said to me voicelessly: 'Of what

consequence are you, Zarathustra? Speak your teaching and break!’ And I answered: ‘Ah, is it my teaching? Who am I ? I await one who is more worthy; I am not worthy even to break by it.’ Then again something said to me voicelessly: ‘Of what consequence are you? You are not yet humble enough. Humility has the toughest hide.’ And I answered: ‘What has the hide of my humility not already endured? I live at the foot of my heights: how high are my peaks? No one has yet told me. But I know my valleys well.’ Then again something said to me voicelessly: ‘O Zarathustra, he who has to move mountains moves valleys and low-lands too.’ And I answered: ‘My words have as yet moved no mountains and what I have spoken has not reached men. Indeed, I went to men, but I have not yet attained them.’ Then again something said to me voicelessly: ‘How do you know that ? The dew falls upon the grass when the night is at its most silent.’ And I answered: ‘They mocked me when I found and walked my own way; and in truth my feet trembled then. ‘And they spoke thus to me: You have forgotten the way, now you will also forget how to walk!’ Then again something said to me voicelessly: ‘Of what consequence is their mockery? You are one who has unlearned how to obey: now you shall command! ‘Do you know what it is all men most need? Him who commands great things. ‘To perform great things is difficult: but more difficult is to command great things. ‘This is the most unpardonable thing about you: You have the power and you will not rule.’ And I answered: ‘I lack the lion’s voice for command.’ Then again something said to me as in a whisper: ‘It is the stillest words which bring the storm. Thoughts that come on doves’ feet guide the world. ‘O Zarathustra, you shall go as a shadow of that which must come: thus you will command and commanding lead the way.’ And I answered: ‘I am ashamed.’ Then again something said to me voicelessly: ‘You must yet become a child and without shame. ‘The pride of youth is still in you, you have become young late: but he who wants to become a child must overcome even his youth.’ And I considered long and trembled. At last, however, I said what I had said at first: ‘I will not.’ Then a laughing broke out around me. Alas, how this laughing tore my body and ripped open my heart! And for the last time something said to me: ‘O Zarathustra, your fruits are ripe but you are not ripe for your fruits! ‘So you must go back into solitude: for you shall yet grow mellow.’ And again something laughed, and fled: then it grew still round me as if with a twofold stillness. I, however, lay on the ground and the sweat poured from my limbs. Now you have heard everything, and why I must return to my solitude. I have kept nothing back from you, my friends. And you have heard, too, who is the most silent of men – and intends to remain so! Ah, my friends! I should have something more to tell you, I should have something more to give you! Why do I not give it? Am I then mean? When Zarathustra had said these words, however, the violence of his grief and the nearness of his departure from his friends overwhelmed him, so that he wept aloud; and no one knew how to comfort him.

But that night he went away alone and forsook his friends. PART THREE ‘ You look up when you desire to be exalted. And I look down, because I am exalted ‘ Who among you can at the same time laugh and be exalted? ‘ He who climbs upon the highest mountains laughs at all tragedies, real or imaginary . ’

ZARATHUSTRA: ‘ Of Reading and Writing ’ The Wanderer I T was midnight when Zarathustra made his way over the ridge of the island, so that he might arrive at the other shore with the early dawn: for there he meant to board ship. For there was a good harbour at which foreign ships, too, liked to drop anchor: they took on board many who wanted to leave the Blissful Islands and cross the sea. Now, as Zarathustra was climbing the mountain he recalled as he went the many lonely wanderings he had made from the time of his youth, and how many mountains and ridges and summits he had already climbed. I am a wanderer and a mountain-climber (he said to his heart), I do not like the plains and it seems I cannot sit still for long. And whatever may yet come to me as fate and experience – a wandering and a mountain-climbing will be in it: in the final analysis one experiences only oneself. The time has passed when accidents could befall me; and what could still come to me that was not already my own? It is returning, at last it is coming home to me – my own Self and those parts of it that have long been abroad and scattered among all things and accidents. And I know one thing more: I stand now before my last summit and before the deed that has been deferred the longest. Alas, I have to climb my most difficult path! Alas, I have started upon my loneliest wandering! But a man of my sort does not avoid such an hour: the hour that says to him: ‘Only now do you tread your path of greatness! Summit and abyss – they are now united in one! ‘You are treading your path of greatness: now what was formerly your ultimate danger has become your ultimate refuge! ‘You are treading your path of greatness: now it must call up all your courage that there is no longer a path behind you! ‘You are treading your path of greatness: no one shall steal after you here! Your foot itself has extinguished the path behind you, and above that path stands written: Impossibility. ‘And when all footholds disappear, you must know how to climb upon your own head: how could you climb upward otherwise? ‘Upon your own head and beyond your own heart! Now the gentlest part of you must become the hardest. ‘He who has always been very indulgent with himself sickens at last through his own indulgence. All praise to what makes hard! I do not praise the land where butter and honey – flow! ‘In order to see much one must learn to look away from oneself – every mountain-climber needs this hardness. ‘But he who, seeking enlightenment, is over-eager with his eyes, how could he see more of a thing than its foreground! ‘You, however, O Zarathustra, have wanted to behold the ground of things and their background: 24 so you must climb above yourself – up and beyond, until you have even your stars under you!’ Yes! To look down upon myself and even upon my stars: that alone would I call my summit , that

has remained for me as my ultimate summit! Thus spoke Zarathustra to himself as he climbed, consoling his heart with hard sayings: for his heart was wounded as never before. And when he arrived at the top of the mountain ridge, behold, there lay the other sea spread out before him: and he stood and was long silent. But the night at this height was cold and dear and bright with stars. I know my fate (he said at last with sadness). Well then! I am ready. My last solitude has just begun. Ah, this sorrowful, black sea beneath me! Ah, this brooding reluctance! Ah, destiny and sea! Now I have to go down to you! I stand before my highest mountain and my longest wandering: therefore I must first descend deeper than I have ever descended, – deeper into pain than I have ever descended, down to its blackest stream! So my destiny will have it. Well then! I am ready. Whence arise the highest mountains? I once asked. Then I learned that they arise from the sea. This testimony is written into their stones and into the sides of their summits. The highest must arise to its height from the deepest. Thus spoke Zarathustra on the mountain summit, where it was cold; when he drew near to the sea, however, and at length stood alone beneath the cliffs, he had grown weary on the way and more yearning than he was before. Everything is still asleep (he said); even the sea is asleep. Its eye looks at me drowsily and strangely. But it breathes warmly; I feel it. And I feel, too, that it is dreaming. Dreaming, it writhes upon a hard pillow. Listen! Listen! How it groans with wicked memories! Or with wicked expectations? Ah, I am sad with you, dark monster, and angry even with myself for your sake. Alas, that my hand has insufficient strength! In truth, I should dearly like to release you from your bad dreams! And as Zarathustra thus spoke, he laughed at himself with melancholy and bitterness. What, Zarathustra! he said, do you want to sing consolation even to the sea? Ah, you fond fool, Zarathustra, too eager to trust! But that is what you have always been: you have always approached trustfully all that is fearful. You have always wanted to caress every monster. A touch of warm breath, a little soft fur on its paw – and at once you have been ready to love and entice it. Love is the danger for the most solitary man, love of any thing if only it is alive! Indeed, my foolishness and modesty in love is laughable! Thus spoke Zarathustra and laughed again: but then he thought of the friends he had left, and he was angry with himself because of his thoughts, as if he had injured his friends with them. And forthwith the laughing man wept – for anger and longing did Zarathustra weep bitterly. Of the Vision and the Riddle 1 W H E N it became rumoured among the sailors that Zarathustra was on the ship – for a man from the Blissful Islands had gone on board at the same time as he – a great curiosity and expectancy arose. But Zarathustra was silent for two days and was cold and deaf for sorrow, so that he responded neither to looks nor to questions. But on the evening of the second day he opened his ears again, although he still remained silent: for there were many strange and dangerous things to hear on this ship, which had come from afar and had yet further to go.

Zarathustra, however, was a friend to all who take long journeys and do not want to live without danger. And behold! in listening his tongue was loosened, and the ice of his heart broke: then he started to speak thus: To you, the bold venturers and adventurers and whoever has embarked with cunning sails upon dreadful seas, to you who are intoxicated by riddles, who take pleasure in twilight, whose soul is lured with flutes to every treacherous abyss – for you do not desire to feel for a rope with cowardly hand; and where you can guess you hate to calculate – to you alone do I tell this riddle that I saw – the vision of the most solitary man. Lately I walked gloomily through a deathly-grey twilight, gloomily and sternly with compressed lips. Not only one sun had gone down for me. A path that mounted defiantly through boulders and rubble, a wicked, solitary path that bush or plant no longer cheered: a mountain path crunched under my foot's defiance. Striding mute over the mocking clatter of pebbles, trampling the stones that made it slip: thus my foot with effort forced itself upward. Upward – despite the spirit that drew it downward, drew it towards the abyss, the Spirit of Gravity, my devil and archenemy. Upward – although he sat upon me, half dwarf, half mole; crippled, crippling; pouring lead-drops into my ear, leaden thoughts into my brain. 'O Zarathustra,' he said mockingly, syllable by syllable, 'you stone of wisdom! You have thrown yourself high, but every stone that is thrown must – fall! 'O Zarathustra, you stone of wisdom, you projectile, you star-destroyer! You have thrown yourself thus high, but every stone that is thrown – must fall! 'Condemned by yourself and to your own stone-throwing: O Zarathustra, far indeed have you thrown your stone, but it will fall back upon you !' Thereupon the dwarf fell silent; and he long continued so. But his silence oppressed me; and to be thus in company is truly more lonely than to be alone! I climbed, I climbed, I dreamed, I thought, but everything oppressed me. I was like a sick man wearied by his sore torment and reawakened from sleep by a worse dream. But there is something in me that I call courage: it has always destroyed every discouragement in me. This courage at last bade me stop and say: 'Dwarf! You! Or I!' For courage is the best destroyer – courage that attacks : for in every attack there is a triumphant shout. Man, however, is the most courageous animal: with his courage he has overcome every animal. With a triumphant shout he has even overcome every pain; human pain, however, is the deepest pain. Courage also destroys giddiness at abysses: and where does man not stand at an abyss? Is seeing itself not – seeing abysses? Courage is the best destroyer: courage also destroys pity. Pity, however, is the deepest abyss: as deeply as man looks into life, so deeply does he look also into suffering. Courage, however, is the best destroyer, courage that attacks: it destroys even death, for it says: 'Was that life? Well then! Once more!' But there is a great triumphant shout in such a saying. He who has ears to hear, let him hear. 2 'Stop, dwarf!' I said. 'I! Or you! But I am the stronger of us two – you do not know my abysmal thought! That thought –

you could not endure!’ Then something occurred which lightened me: for the dwarf jumped from my shoulder, the inquisitive dwarf! And he squatted down upon a stone in front of me. But a gateway stood just where we had halted. ‘Behold this gateway, dwarf!’ I went on: ‘it has two aspects. Two paths come together here: no one has ever reached their end. ‘This long lane behind us: it goes on for an eternity. And that long lane ahead of us – that is another eternity. ‘They are in opposition to one another, these paths; they abut on one another: and it is here at this gateway that they come together. The name of the gateway is written above it: “Moment”. ‘But if one were to follow them further and ever further and further: do you think, dwarf, that these paths would be in eternal opposition?’ ‘Everything straight lies,’ murmured the dwarf disdainfully. ‘All truth is crooked, time itself is a circle.’ ‘Spirit of Gravity!’ I said angrily, ‘do not treat this too lightly! Or I shall leave you squatting where you are, Lame-foot – and I have carried you high! ‘Behold this moment!’ I went on. ‘From this gateway Moment a long, eternal lane runs back : an eternity lies behind us. ‘Must not all things that can run have already run along this lane? Must not all things that can happen have already happened, been done, run past? ‘And if all things have been here before: what do you think of this moment, dwarf? Must not this gateway, too, have been here – before? ‘And are not all things bound fast together in such a way that this moment draws after it all future things? Therefore – draws itself too? ‘For all things that can run must also run once again forward along this long lane. ‘And this slow spider that creeps along in the moonlight, and this moonlight itself, and I and you at this gateway whispering together, whispering of eternal things – must we not all have been here before? ‘ – and must we not return and run down that other lane out before us, down that long, terrible lane – must we not return eternally?’ Thus I spoke, and I spoke more and more softly: for I was afraid of my own thoughts and reservations. Then, suddenly, I heard a dog howling nearby. Had I ever heard a dog howling in that way? My thoughts ran back. Yes! When I was a child, in my most distant childhood: – then I heard a dog howling in that way. And I saw it, too, bristling, its head raised, trembling in the stillest midnight, when even dogs believe in ghosts: – so that it moved me to pity. For the full moon had just gone over the house, silent as death, it had just stopped still, a round glow, still upon the flat roof as if upon a forbidden place: that was what had terrified the dog: for dogs believe in thieves and ghosts. And when I heard such howling again, it moved me to pity again. Where had the dwarf now gone? And the gateway? And the spider? And all the whispering? Had I been dreaming? Had I awoken? All at once I was standing between wild cliffs, alone, desolate in the most desolate moonlight. But there a man was lying! And there! The dog, leaping, bristling, whining; then it saw me coming – then it howled again, then it cried out – had I ever heard a dog cry so for help? 25 And truly, I had never seen the like of what I

then saw. I saw a young shepherd writhing, choking, convulsed, his face distorted; and a heavy, black snake was hanging out of his mouth. Had I ever seen so much disgust and pallid horror on a face? Had he, perhaps, been asleep? Then the snake had crawled into his throat – and there it had bitten itself fast. My hands tugged and tugged at the snake – in vain! they could not tug the snake out of the shepherd's throat. Then a voice cried from me: 'Bite! Bite! 'Its head off! Bite!' – thus a voice cried from me, my horror, my hate, my disgust, my pity, all my good and evil cried out of me with a single cry. You bold men around me! You venturers, adventurers, and those of you who have embarked with cunning sails upon undiscovered seas! You who take pleasure in riddles! Solve for me the riddle that I saw, interpret to me the vision of the most solitary man! For it was a vision and a premonition: what did I see in allegory? And who is it that must come one day? Who is the shepherd into whose mouth the snake thus crawled? Who is the man into whose throat all that is heaviest, blackest will thus crawl? The shepherd, however, bit as my cry had advised him; he bit with a good bite! He spat far away the snake's head – and sprang up. No longer a shepherd, no longer a man – a transformed being, surrounded with light, laughing ! Never yet on earth had any man laughed as he laughed! O my brothers, I heard a laughter that was no human laughter – and now a thirst consumes me, a longing that is never stilled. My longing for this laughter consumes me: oh how do I endure still to live! And how could I endure to die now! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of Involuntary Bliss WITH such riddles and bitterness in his heart did Zarathustra fare across the sea. When he was four days' journey from the Blissful Islands and from his friends, however, he had overcome all his pain – triumphantly and with firm feet he again accepted his destiny. 26 And then Zarathustra spoke thus to his rejoicing conscience: I am again alone and willingly so, alone with the pure sky and the open sea; and again it is afternoon around me. It was afternoon when I once found my friends for the first time, it was afternoon, too, when I found them a second time – at the hour when all light grows stiller. For whatever happiness that is still travelling between heaven and earth now seeks shelter in a luminous soul: with happiness all light has now grown stiller. O afternoon of my life! Once my happiness, too, climbed down into the valley to seek a shelter: there it found these open, hospitable souls. O afternoon of my life! What have I not given away that I might possess one thing: this living plantation of my thoughts and this dawn of my highest hope! Once the creator sought companions and children of his hope: and behold, it turned out that he could not find them, except he first create them himself. Thus I am in the midst of my work, going to my children and turning from them: for the sake of his children must Zarathustra perfect himself. For one loves from the very heart only one's child and one's work; and where there is great love of oneself, then it is a sign of pregnancy: thus have I found. My children are still green in their first spring, standing close together and

shaken in common by the winds, the trees of my garden and my best soil. And truly! Where such trees stand together, there blissful islands are! But one day I will uproot them and set each one up by itself, that it may learn solitude and defiance and foresight. Then it shall stand by the sea, gnarled and twisted and with supple hardiness, a living lighthouse of unconquerable life. Yonder, where storms plunge down into the sea and the mountain's snout drinks water, there each of them shall one day keep its day and night watch, for its testing and recognition. It shall be tested and recognized, to see whether it is of my kind and my race – whether it is master of a protracted will, silent even when it speaks, and giving in such a way that in giving it takes – that it may one day be my companion and a fellow-creator and fellow-rejoicer of Zarathustra – such a one as inscribes my will upon my tablets: for the greater perfection of all things. And for its sake, and for those like it, must I perfect myself : therefore I now avoid my happiness and offer myself to all unhappiness – for my ultimate testing and recognition. And truly, it was time I went; and the wanderer's shadow and the longest sojourn and the stillest hour – all told me: 'It is high time!' The wind blew to me through the keyhole and said: 'Come!' The door sprang cunningly open and said: 'Go!' But I lay fettered to love of my children: desire set this snare for me, desire for love, that I might become my children's victim and lose myself through them. To desire – that now means to me: to have lost myself. I possess you, my children! In this possession all should be certainty and nothing desire. But the sun of my love lay brooding upon me, Zarathustra stewed in his own juice – then shadows and doubts flew past me. I hankered after frost and winter: 'Oh that frost and winter would again make me crackle and crunch!' I sighed: then icy mist arose from me. My past broke open its graves, many a pain buried alive awoke: they had only been sleeping, concealed in winding sheets. Thus in symbols everything called to me: 'It is time!' But I – did not hear: until at last my abyss stirred and my thought bit me. Alas, abysmal thought that is my thought! When shall I find the strength to hear you boring and no longer tremble? My heart rises to my throat when I hear you boring I Even your silence threatens to choke me, you abysmal, silent thought! I have never yet dared to summon you up : it has been enough that I – carried you with me! I have not yet been strong enough for the ultimate lion's arrogance and lion's wantonness. Your heaviness has always been fearful enough for me: but one day I shall find the strength and the lion's voice to summon you up! When I have overcome myself in that, I will overcome myself in that which is greater; and a victory shall be the seal of my perfection! In the meantime, I travel on uncertain seas; smooth-tongued chance flatters me; I gaze forward and backward, still I see no end. The hour of my last struggle has not yet arrived – or has it perhaps just arrived? Truly, sea and life around me gaze at me with insidious beauty! O afternoon of my life! O happiness before evening! O harbour in mid-sea! O peace in uncertainty! How

I mistrust you all! Truly, I am mistrustful of your insidious beauty! I am like the lover who mistrusts all-too-velvety smiles. As the jealous man thrusts his best beloved from him, tender even in his hardness – thus do I thrust this blissful hour from me. Away with you, blissful hour! With you there came to me an involuntary bliss! I stand here ready for my deepest pain – you came out of season! Away with you, blissful hour! Rather take shelter yonder – with my children! Hurry, and bless them before evening with my happiness! There evening already approaches: the sun is sinking. Away – my happiness! Thus spoke Zarathustra. And he waited all night for his unhappiness: but he waited in vain. The night remained clear and still and happiness itself drew nearer and nearer to him. Towards morning, however, Zarathustra laughed to his heart and said ironically: ‘Happiness runs after me. That is because I do not run after women. Happiness, however, is a woman.’ Before Sunrise O SKY above me! O pure, deep sky! You abyss of light! Gazing into you, I tremble with divine desires. To cast myself into your height – that is my depth! To hide myself in your purity – that is my innocence! The god is veiled by his beauty: thus you hide your stars. You do not speak: thus you proclaim to me your wisdom. You have risen for me today, mute over the raging sea; your love and your modesty speak a revelation to my raging soul. That you have come to me, beautiful, veiled in your beauty; that you have spoken to me mutely, manifest in your wisdom: Oh how should I not divine all that is modest in your soul! You came to me before the sun, to me the most solitary man. We have been friends from the beginning: we have grief and terror and world in common; we have even the sun in common. We do not speak to one another, because we know too much: we are silent together, we smile our knowledge to one another. Are you not the light of my fire? Do you not have the sister-soul of my insight? Together we learned everything; together we learned to mount above ourselves to ourselves and to smile uncloudedly – to smile uncloudedly down from bright eyes and from miles away when under us compulsion and purpose and guilt stream like rain. And when I wandered alone, what did my soul hunger after by night and on treacherous paths? And when I climbed mountains, whom did I always seek, if not you, upon mountains? And all my wandering and mountain-climbing: it was merely a necessity and an expedient of clumsiness: my whole will desires only fly, to fly into you! And what have I hated more than passing clouds and all that defiles you? And I have hated even my own hatred, because it defiled you! I dislike the passing clouds, these stealthy cats of prey: they take from you and from me what we have in common – the vast and boundless declaration of Yes and Amen. We dislike these mediators and mixers, the passing clouds: these half-and-halfers, who have learned neither to bless nor to curse from the heart. I would rather sit in a barrel under a closed sky, rather sit in an abyss without a sky, than see you, luminous sky, defiled by passing clouds! And often I longed to

bind them fast with jagged golden wires of lightning, so that I, like the thunder, might drum upon their hollow bellies – an angry drummer, because they rob me of your Yes! and Amen! O sky above me, you pure sky! You luminous sky! You abyss of light! – because they rob me of my Yes! and Amen! For I would rather have noise and thunder and storm-curses than this cautious, uncertain feline repose; and among men, too, I hate most all soft-walkers and half-and-halfers and uncertain, hesitating passing clouds. And ‘He who cannot bless shall learn to curse!’ – this clear teaching fell to me from the dear sky, this star stands in my sky even on dark nights. I, however, am one who blesses and declares Yes, if only you are around me, you pure, luminous sky! You abyss of light I – then into all abysses do I carry my consecrating declaration Yes. I have become one who blesses and one who declares Yes: and for that I wrestled long and was a wrestler, so that I might one day have my hands free for blessing. This, however, is my blessing: To stand over everything as its own sky, as its round roof, its azure bell and eternal certainty: and happy is he who thus blesses! For all things are baptized at the fount of eternity and beyond good and evil; good and evil themselves, however, are only intervening shadows and damp afflictions and passing clouds. Truly, it is a blessing and not a blasphemy when I teach: ‘Above all things stands the heaven of chance, the heaven of innocence, the heaven of accident, the heaven of wantonness.’ 27 ‘Lord Chance’ 28 – he is the world’s oldest nobility, which I have given back to all things; I have released them from servitude under purpose. I set this freedom and celestial cheerfulness over all things like an azure bell when I taught that no ‘eternal will’ acts over them and through them. I set this wantonness and this foolishness in place of that will when I taught: ‘With all things one thing is impossible – rationality!’ A little reason, to be sure, a seed of wisdom scattered from star to star – this leaven is mingled with all things: for the sake of foolishness is wisdom mingled with all things! A little wisdom is no doubt possible; but I have found this happy certainty in all things: that they prefer – to dance on the feet of chance. O sky above me, you pure, lofty sky! This is now your purity to me, that there is no eternal reason-spider and spider’s web in you – that you are to me a dance floor for divine chances, that you are to me a gods’ table for divine dice and dicers! But are you blushing? Did I say something unspeakable? Did I slander you when I meant to bless you? Or is it the shame of our being together which makes you blush? Are you telling me to go and be silent because now – day is coming? The world is deep: and deeper than day has ever comprehended. Not everything may be spoken in the presence of day. But day is coming: so let us part! O sky above me, you modest, glowing sky! O you, my happiness before sunrise! Day is coming: so let us part! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Virtue that Makes Small 1 WHEN Zarathustra was again on firm land he did not go off straightway to his mountains and his cave, but made many journeys and asked many questions and

inquired of this and that, so that he said jokingly of himself: ‘Behold a river that flows back to its source through many meanderings!’ For he wanted to learn what had been happening to men while he had been away: whether they had become bigger or smaller. And once he saw a row of new houses, and he marvelled and said: What do these houses mean? Truly, no great soul put them up as its image! Did a silly child perhaps take them out of its toy-box? If only another child would put them back into its box! And these sitting-rooms and bedrooms: are men able to go in and out of them? They seem to have been made for dolls; or for dainty nibblers who perhaps let others nibble with them. And Zarathustra stopped and considered. At length he said sadly: ‘Everything has become smaller! ‘Everywhere I see lower doors: anyone like me can still pass through them, but – he has to stoop! ‘Oh when shall I return to my home, where I shall no longer have to stoop – shall no longer have to stoop before the small men ’! And Zarathustra sighed and gazed into the distance. The same day, however, he spoke his discourse upon the virtue that makes small. 2 I go among this people and keep my eyes open: they do not forgive me that I am not envious of their virtues. They peck at me because I tell them: For small people small virtues are necessary – and because it is hard for me to understand that small people are necessary! Here I am still like a cockerel in a strange farmyard, who is pecked at even by the hens; but I am not unfriendly to these hens on that account. I am polite towards them, as towards every small vexation; to be prickly towards small things seems to me the wisdom of a hedgehog. They all talk of me when they sit around the fire at evening – they talk of me, but no one thinks – of me! This is the new silence I have learned: their noise about me spreads a cloak over my thoughts. They bluster among themselves: ‘What does this gloomy cloud want with us? Let us see that it does not bring us a pestilence!’ And recently a woman pulled back her child when it was coming towards me: ‘Take the children away!’ she cried; ‘such eyes scorch children’s souls.’ They cough when I speak: they think that coughing is an objection to strong winds – they know nothing of the raging of my happiness! ‘We have no time yet for Zarathustra’ – thus they object; but of what consequence is a time that ‘has no time’ for Zarathustra? And should they even praise me: how could I rest on their praise? Their praise is a barbed girdle to me: it scratches me even when I take it off. And I have learned this, too, among them: he who praises appears to be giving back, in truth however he wants to be given more! Ask my foot if it likes their melodies of praise and enticement! Truly, to such a measure and tick-tock beat it likes neither to dance nor to stand still. They would like to lure and commend me to small virtue; they would like to persuade my foot to the tick-tock measure of a small happiness. I go among this people and keep my eyes open: they have become smaller and are becoming ever smaller: and their doctrine of happiness and virtue is the cause For they are modest even in virtue – for they want ease. But only a

modest virtue is compatible with ease. To be sure, even they learn in their own way how to stride and to stride forward: that is what I call their limping . Therewith they become a hindrance to anyone who is in a hurry. And some of them go forward and at the same time look backward with a stiff neck: I like to run up against them. Foot and eye should not lie, nor give one another the lie. But there is much lying among the small people. Some of them will , but most of them are only willed . Some of them are genuine, but most of them are bad actors. There are unconscious actors among them and involuntary actors – the genuine are always rare, especially genuine actors. There is little manliness here: therefore their women make themselves manly. For only he who is sufficiently a man will – redeem the woman in woman. And I have found this hypocrisy the worst among them: that even those who command affect the virtues of those who obey. ‘I serve, you serve, we serve’ – so here even the hypocrisy of the rulers intones – and alas, if the first ruler is only the first servant! Ah, my eyes’ curiosity has strayed even into their hypocrisies; and I have divined well all their fly-happiness and their humming around sunny window-panes. I see as much weakness as goodness. As much weakness as justice and pity. They are frank, honest, and kind to one another, as grains of sand are frank, honest, and kind to grains of sand. To embrace modestly a little happiness – that they call ‘submission’! And at the same time they are looking out for a new little happiness. Fundamentally they want one thing most of all: that nobody shall do them harm. So they steal a march on everyone and do good to everyone. This, however, is cowardice : although it be called ‘virtue’. And when they speak harshly, these little people, I hear in it only their hoarseness – every draught, in fact, makes them hoarse. They are clever, their virtues have clever fingers. But they lack fists, their fingers do not know how to fold into fists. To them, virtue is what makes modest and tame: with it they make the wolf into a dog and man himself into man’s best domestic animal. ‘We have set our chairs down in the middle ’ – that is what their smirking tells me – ‘and as far away from dying warriors as from contented swine.’ This, however, is – mediocrity : although it be called moderation. 3 I go among this people and let fall many a word; but they know neither how to take nor to keep. They are surprised that I have not come to rail at their lusts and vices; and truly, I have not come to warn against pickpockets, either! They are surprised that I am not prepared to improve and sharpen their cleverness: as if they had not already sufficient wiseacres, whose voices grate on me like slate-pencils! And when I cry: ‘Curse all the cowardly devils within you who would like to whimper and clasp their hands and worship,’ then they cry: ‘Zarathustra is godless.’ And this is especially the cry of their teachers of submission; but it is into precisely their ears that I love to shout: Yes! I am Zarathustra the Godless! These teachers of submission! Wherever there is anything small and sick and scabby, there they crawl like lice; and only my

disgust stops me from cracking them. Well then! This is my sermon for their ears: I am Zarathustra the Godless, who says ‘Who is more godless than I, that I may rejoice in his teaching?’ I am Zarathustra the Godless: where shall I find my equal? All those who give themselves their own will and renounce all submission, they are my equals. I am Zarathustra the Godless: I cook every chance in my pot. And only when it is quite cooked do I welcome it as my food. And truly, many a chance came imperiously to me: but my will spoke to it even more imperiously, then it went down imploringly on its knees – imploring shelter and love with me, and urging in wheedling tones: ‘Just see, O Zarathustra, how a friend comes to a friend!’ But why do I speak where no one has my kind of ears? And so I will shout it out to all the winds: You will become smaller and smaller, you small people! You will crumble away, you comfortable people! You will yet perish – through your many small virtues, through your many small omissions, through your many small submissions! Too indulgent, too yielding: that is the state of your soil! But in order to grow big, a tree wants to strike hard roots into hard rocks! Even what you omit weaves at the web of mankind’s future; even your nothing is a spider’s web and a spider that lives on the future’s blood. And when you take, it is like stealing, you small virtuous people; but even among rogues, honour says: ‘One should steal only where one cannot plunder.’ ‘It is given’ – that is also a doctrine of submission. But I tell you, you comfortable people: it is taken, and will be taken more and more from you! 29 Oh, that you would put from you all half willing, and decide upon lethargy as you do upon action! Oh, that you understood my saying: ‘Always do what you will – but first be such as can will! ‘Always love your neighbour as yourselves – but first be such as love themselves – ‘such as love with a great love, such as love with a great contempt!’ Thus speaks Zarathustra the Godless. But why do I speak where no one has my kind of ears? Here it is yet an hour too early for me. Among this people I am my own forerunner, my own cock-crow through dark lanes. But their hour is coming! And mine too is coming! Hourly will they become smaller, poorer, more barren – poor weeds! poor soil! And soon they shall stand before me like arid grass and steppe, and truly! weary of themselves – and longing for fire rather than for water! O blessed hour of the lightning! O mystery before noontide! One day I shall turn them into running fire and heralds with tongues of flame – one day they shall proclaim with tongues of flame: It is coming, it is near, the great noontide! Thus spoke Zarathustra. On the Mount of Olives WINTER, an ill guest, sits in my house; my hands are blue from his friendly handshake. I honour him, this ill guest, but I am glad to let him sit alone. I gladly run away from him; and if you run well you can escape him! With warm feet and warm thoughts do I run yonder where the wind is still, to the sunny corner of my mount of olives. There I laugh at my stern guest and am still fond of him, for he drives the flies away and silences many little noises for me at home. For he will

not permit even a gnat to buzz about, far less two gnats; and he makes the streets lonely, so that the moonlight is afraid there at night. He is a hard guest, but I honour him, and do not pray to a fat-bellied fire-idol, as the weaklings do. Rather a little chattering of teeth than idol-worship! – so my nature will have it. And I especially detest all lustful, steaming, musty fire-idols. Whom I love I love better in winter than in summer; I now mock my enemies better and more heartily, since winter sits in my home. Heartily, in truth, even when I crawl into bed – even there my hidden happiness laughs and grows wanton; even my deceptive dream laughs. I, a – crawler? Never in my life have I crawled before the powerful; and if I ever lied, I lied from love. For that reason I am joyful even in my winter bed. A meagre bed warms me more than an opulent one, for I am jealous of my poverty. And it is most faithful to me in the winter. I start each day with a wickedness, I mock winter with a cold bath: my stern house-companion grumbles at that. I also like to tickle him with a wax candle: so that he may finally let the sky emerge from an ash-grey dawn. For I am especially wicked in the morning: at the early hour when the bucket clatters at the well and horses neigh warmly in grey streets. Then I wait impatiently, until the luminous sky at last dawns for me, the snowy-bearded winter sky, the white-haired, ancient sky – the silent, whiter sky, that often conceals even its sun! Did I learn long, luminous silence from it? Or did it learn it from me? Or did each of us devise it himself? The origin of all good things is thousand fold – all good, wanton things spring for joy into existence: how should they do that – once only? Long silence is also a good, wanton thing, and to gaze like the winter sky from a luminous, round-eyed countenance – like it, to conceal one's sun and one's inflexible sun-will: truly, I have learned well this art and this winter wantonness! It is my favourite wickedness and art, that my silence has learned not to betray itself by silence. Rattling words and dice have I outwitted the solemn attendants: my will and purpose shall elude all the stern watchers. So that no one might see down into my profundity and ultimate will – that is why I devised my long, luminous silence. I have found so many shrewd men who veiled their faces and troubled their waters, so that no one might see through them and under them. But the shrewder distrusters and nut-crackers came straight to them: straightway they fished out their best-hidden fish! But the clear, the honest, the transparent – they seem to me the shrewdest silent men: those whose profundity is so deep that even the clearest water does not – betray it. You snowy-bearded winter sky, you round-eyed, white-haired sky above me! O you heavenly image of my soul and its wantonness! And do I not have to hide myself, like one who has swallowed gold, so that my soul shall not be slit open? Do I not have to wear stilts, so that they may not notice my long legs – all these envious and injurious people around me? These reeky, cosy, worn-out, mouldy, woebegone souls – how could their envy endure my happiness? So I show them only ice and winter on my peaks – and not

that my mountain also winds all the girdles of sunlight around it! They hear only the whistling of my winter storms: and not that I also fare over warm seas, like passionate, heavy, hot south winds. They even pity my accidents and chances: but my doctrine is: 'Let chance come to me: it is as innocent as a little child!' How could they endure my happiness, if I did not put accidents and the miseries of winter and fur-hats and coverings of snow-clouds around my happiness! – if I did not myself pity their pity, the pity of these envious and injurious people! – if I myself did not sigh and let my teeth chatter in their presence, and patiently let myself be wrapped up in their pity! This is the wise wantonness and benevolence of my soul: it does not bide its winter and frosty storms; neither does it hide its chilblains. For one person, solitude is the escape of an invalid; for another, solitude is escape from the invalids. Let them bear me chattering and sighing with winter cold, all these poor, squint-eyed knaves around me! With such sighing and chattering have I escaped their heated rooms. Let them pity me and sigh with me over my chilblains: 'He will yet freeze to death on the ice of knowledge!' – so they wail. In the meanwhile, I run with warm feet hither and thither upon my mount of olives: in the sunny corner of my mount of olives do I sing and mock all pity. Thus sang Zarathustra. Of Passing By

THUS, slowly making his way among many people and through divers towns, did Zarathustra return indirectly to his mountain and his cave. And behold, on his way he came unawares to the gate of the great city; here, however, a frothing fool with hands outstretched sprang at him and blocked his path. But this was the fool the people called 'Zarathustra's ape': for he had learned from him something of the composition and syntax of language and perhaps also liked to borrow from his store of wisdom. The fool, however, spoke thus to Zarathustra: O Zarathustra, here is the great city: here you have nothing to seek and everything to lose. Why do you want to wade through this mud? Take pity on your feet! Rather spit upon the gate and – turn back! Here is the Hell for hermits' thoughts: here great thoughts are boiled alive and cooked small. Here all great emotions decay: here only little, dry emotions may rattle! Do you not smell already the slaughter-houses and cook-shops of the spirit? Does this city not reek of the fumes of slaughtered spirit? Do you not see the souls hanging like dirty, limp rags? – And they also make newspapers from these rags! Have you not heard how the spirit has here become a play with words? It vomits out repulsive verbal swill! – And they also make newspapers from this verbal swill. They pursue one another and do not know where. They inflame one another, and do not know why. They rattle their tins, they jingle their gold. They are cold and seek warmth in distilled waters; they are inflamed and seek coolness in frozen spirits; they are all ill and diseased with public opinion. All lusts and vices are at home here; but there are virtuous people here, too, there are many adroit, useful virtues: Many adroit virtues with scribbling fingers and behinds hardened to sitting and waiting,

blessed with little chest decorations and padded, rumpless daughters. There is also much piety here and much devout spittle-licking and fawning before the God of Hosts. Down 'from on high' drips the star and the gracious spittle; every starless breast longs to go up 'on high'. The moon has its court, and the court has its mooncalves: to all that comes from the court, however, do the paupers and all the adroit pauper-virtues pray. 'I serve, you serve, we serve' – thus does all adroit virtue pray to the prince: so that the merited star may at last be fastened to the narrow breast. But the moon still revolves around all that is earthly: so the prince, too, still revolves around what is most earthly of all: that, however, is the shopkeepers' gold. The God of Hosts is not the god of the golden ingots; the prince proposes, but the shopkeeper – disposes! By all that is luminous and strong and good in you, O Zarathustra! spit upon this city of shopkeepers and turn back! Here all blood flows foul and tepid and frothy through all veins: spit upon the great city that is the great rubbish pile where all the scum froths together! Spit upon the city of flattened souls and narrow breasts, of slant eyes and sticky fingers – upon the city of the importunate, the shameless, the ranters in writing and speech, the overheated ambitious: where everything rotten, disreputable, lustful, gloomy, overripe, ulcerous, conspiratorial festers together – spit upon the great city and turn back! But here Zarathustra interrupted the frothing fool and stopped his mouth. Have done! (cried Zarathustra) Your speech and your kind have long disgusted me! Why did you live so long in the swamp that you had to become a frog and toad yourself? Does not foul, foaming swamp-blood now flow through your own veins, so that you have learned to quack and rail like this? Why did you not go into the forest? Or plough the earth? Is the sea not full of green islands? I despise your contempt; and since you warned me, why did you not warn yourself? My contempt and my bird of warning shall ascend from love alone; not from the swamp! They call you my ape, you frothing fool: but I call you my grunting pig – by grunting you are undoing even my praise of folly. What, then, was it that started you grunting? That nobody had flattered you enough: therefore you sat down beside this filth, so that you might have cause for much grunting – so that you might have cause for much revenge! For all your frothing, you vain fool, is revenge; I have divined you well! But your foolish teaching is harmful to me, even when you are right I And if Zarathustra's teaching were a hundred times justified, you would still – use my teaching falsely! Thus spoke Zarathustra; and he looked at the great city, sighed and was long silent. At length he spoke thus: This great city, and not only this fool, disgusts me. In both there is nothing to make better, nothing to make worse. Woe to this great city! And I wish I could see already the pillar of fire in which it will be consumed! For such pillars of fire must precede the great noontide. Yet this has its time and its own destiny. But I offer you in farewell this precept, you fool: Where one can no longer love, one should – pass by! Thus spoke

Zarathustra and passed by the fool and the great city. Of the Apostates 1 A LAS , everything that lately stood green and motley in this meadow already lies faded and grey! And how much honey of hope have I carried from here into my beehives! All these young hearts have already grown old – and not even old! only weary, common, comfortable: they describe it: ‘We have grown pious again.’ But lately I saw them running out in the early morning with bold feet: but the feet of their knowledge grew weary and now they slander even their morning boldness! Truly, many of them once lifted their legs like a dancer, the laughter in my wisdom beckoned to them: then they considered. And now I have seen them bent – to creep to the Cross. Once they fluttered around light and freedom like flies and young poets. A little older, a little colder: and already they are mystifiers and mutterers and stay-at-homes. Did their hearts perhaps despair because solitude devoured me like a whale? Did their ears perhaps listen long and longingly in vain for me and for my trumpet and herald calls? Alas! They are always few whose heart possesses a long-enduring courage and wantonness; and in such, the spirit, too, is patient. The remainder, however, are cowardly. The remainder: that is always the majority, the commonplace, the superfluity, the many-too-many – all these are cowardly! He who is of my sort will also encounter experiences of my sort, so that his first companions must be corpses and buffoons. His second companions, however, will call themselves his believers : a lively flock, full of love, full of folly, full of adolescent adoration. He among men who is of my sort should not grapple his heart to these believers; he who knows fickle-cowardly human nature should not believe in these springs and many-coloured meadows! If they could do otherwise, they would choose otherwise. The half-and-half spoil every whole. Why complain because leaves wither? Let them fall, let them go, O Zarathustra, and do not complain I Rather blow among them with rustling winds – blow among these leaves, O Zarathustra: so that all that is withered may run from you the faster. 2 ‘We have grown pious again’ – thus these apostates confess; and many of them are still too cowardly to confess it. I look into their eyes, then I tell them to their face and to the blushes of their cheeks: You are those who again pray! But it is a disgrace to pray! Not for everyone, but for you and me and for whoever else has his conscience in his head. For joy it is a disgrace to pray! You know it well: the cowardly devil in you who would like to clasp his hands and to fold his arms and to take it easier: – it was this cowardly devil who persuaded you: ‘There is a God!’ Through that , however, have you become one of those who dread the light, whom light never lets rest; now you must stick your head deeper every day into night and fog! And truly, you have chosen well the hour: for even now the night-birds have again flown out. The hour has arrived for all people who fear the light, the evening hour of ease when there is no – ‘ease’ for them. I hear and smell it: the hour for their chase and procession has arrived; not indeed for a wild chase, but for a

tame, lame, snuffling, soft-walker's and soft-prayer's chase – for a chase after soulful hypocrites: all mousetraps of the heart have now again been set! And wherever I raise a curtain, a little night-moth comes fluttering out. Has it perhaps been crouching there with another little night-moth? For everywhere I smell little hidden communities; and wherever there are closets, there are new devotees in them and the atmosphere of devotees. They sit together on long evenings and say: 'Let us again become as little children and say Dear God!' – ruined in mouth and stomach by the pious confectioners. Or they observe on long evenings a cunning, lurking Cross-spider, which preaches prudence to the spiders themselves and teaches: 'There is good spinning under Crosses!' Or they sit all day with fishing-rods beside swamps and for that reason think themselves deep; but he who fishes where there are no fish I do not call even superficial! Or they learn to play the harp in pious-joyful style with a song-poet who would like to harp his way into the hearts of young women – for he has grown weary of the old women and their praises. Or they learn to shudder with a learned half-madman who waits in darkened rooms so that the spirits may come to him – and the spirit 30 has quite departed! Or they listen to an old, roving, whistling tramp who has learned from the distressful winds the distress of tones; now he whistles like the wind and preaches distress in distressful tones. And some of them have even become night-watchmen: now they know how to blow horns and to go around at night and awaken old things that have long been asleep. I heard five sayings about old things last night beside the garden wall: they came from such old, distressed, dried-up night-watchmen: 'For a father he does not look after his children enough: human fathers do it better!' 'He is too old! He no longer looks after his children at all'-thus the other night-watchman answered. 'Has he any children? No one can prove it, if he doesn't prove it himself! I have long wished he would prove it thoroughly for once.' 'Prove it? As if he has ever proved anything! He finds it hard to prove things; he thinks it very important that people should believe him.' 'Yes, yes! Belief makes him happy, belief in him. Old people are like that I So shall we be, too!' Thus the two old night-watchmen and light-scarecrows spoke together and thereupon blew their horns distressfully: so it happened last night beside the garden wall. My heart, however, writhed with laughter and was like to break and knew not where to go and sank into the midriff. Truly, it will yet be the death of me, to choke with laughter when I see asses intoxicated and hear night-watchmen thus doubt God. For has not the time for all such doubts long since passed? Who may still awaken such old, sleeping, light-shunning things! With the old gods, they have long since met their end – and truly, they had a fine, merry, divine ending! They did not 'fade away in twilight' 31 – that is a lie! On the contrary: they once – laughed themselves to death! That happened when the most godless saying proceeded from a god himself, the saying: 'There is one God! You shall have no other gods before me!'

– an old wrath-beard of a god, a jealous god, thus forgot himself: And all the gods laughed then and rocked in their chairs and cried: ‘Is not precisely this godliness, that there are gods but no God?’ He who has ears to hear, let him hear. Thus spoke Zarathustra in the town which he loved and which is called ‘The Pied Cow’. For from here he had only two days to go before arriving again at his cave and his animals; and his soul rejoiced continually at the nearness of his home-coming. The Home-Coming O SOLITUDE ! Solitude, my home ! I have lived too long wildly in wild strange lands to come home to you without tears! Now shake your finger at me as mothers do, now smile at me as mothers smile, now say merely: ‘And who was it that once stormed away from me like a storm-wind? – ‘who departing cried: I have sat too long with Solitude, I have unlearned how to be silent! You have surely learned that – now? ‘O Zarathustra, I know all: and that you were lonelier among the crowd, you solitary, than you ever were with me! ‘Loneliness is one thing, solitude another: you have learned that – now! And that among men you will always be wild and strange: ‘wild and strange even when they love you: for above all they want to be indulged! ‘But here you are at your own hearth and home; here you can utter everything and pour out every reason, nothing is here ashamed of hidden, hardened feelings. ‘Here all things come caressingly to your discourse and flatter you: for they want to ride upon your back. Upon every image you here ride to every truth. ‘Here you may speak to all things straight and true: and truly, it sounds as praise to their ears, that someone should speak with all things – honestly! ‘But it is another thing to be lonely. For, do you remember, O Zarathustra? When once your bird cried above you as you stood in the forest undecided, ignorant where to go, beside a corpse. ‘When you said: May my animals lead me! I found it more dangerous among men than among animals. That was loneliness! ‘And do you remember, O Zarathustra? When you sat upon your island, a well of wine among empty buckets, giving and distributing, bestowing and out-pouring among the thirsty: ‘until at last you sat alone thirsty among the intoxicated and lamented each night: “Is it not more blessed to receive than to give? And more blessed to steal than to receive?” – That was loneliness! ‘And do you remember, O Zarathustra? When your stillest hour came and tore you forth from yourself, when it said in an evil whisper: “Speak and break!” – ‘when it made you repent of all your waiting and silence and discouraged your humble courage: That was loneliness!’ O Solitude! Solitude, my home I How blissfully and tenderly does your voice speak to me! We do not question one another, we do not complain to one another, we go openly together through open doors. For with you all is open and clear; and here even the hours run on lighter feet. For time weighs down more heavily in the dark than in the light. Here, the words and word-chests of all existence spring open to me: all existence here wants to become words, all becoming here wants to learn speech from me. Down there, however – all speech is in vain! There, the

best wisdom is to forget and pass by: I have learned that – now! He who wants to understand all things among men has to touch all things. But my hands are too clean for that. I even dislike to breathe in their breath; alas, that I lived so long among their noise and bad breath! O blissful stillness around me! O pure odours around me! Oh, how this stillness draws pure breath from a deep breast! Oh, how it listens, this blissful stillness! But down there – everything speaks, everything is unheard. One may ring in one's wisdom with bells – the shopkeeper in the market-place will out-ring it with pennies! Everything among them speaks, no one knows any longer how to understand. Everything falls away into failure, nothing falls any longer into deep wells. Everything among them speaks, nothing prospers and comes to an end any longer. Everything cackles, but who still wants to sit quietly upon the nest and hatch eggs? Everything among them speaks, everything is talked down. And what yesterday was still too hard for time itself and its teeth, today hangs chewed and picked from the mouth of the men of today. Everything among them speaks, everything is betrayed. And what was once called a secret and a secrecy of profound souls, today belongs to the street-trumpeters and other butterflies. O humankind, you strange thing! You noise in dark streets! Now again you lie behind me – my greatest danger lies behind me! My greatest danger always lay in indulgence and sufferance; and all humankind wants to be indulged and suffered. With truths held back, with foolish hand and foolish-fond heart and rich in pity's little lies – that is how I used to live among men. I sat among them disguised, ready to misunderstand myself so that I might endure them, and glad to tell myself: 'You fool, you do not know men!' One forgets what one has learned about men when one lives among men: there is too much foreground in all men – what can far-seeing, far-seeking eyes do there! And when they misunderstood me, I, like a fool, indulged them more than I did myself: for I was accustomed to being hard with myself and often even taking revenge on myself for this indulgence. Stung by poisonous flies and hollowed out like a stone by many drops of wickedness: that is how I sat among them and still told myself: 'Everything small is innocent of its smallness!' Especially those who call themselves 'the good' did I discover to be the most poisonous flies: they sting in all innocence; how could they be – just towards me! Pity teaches him to lie who lives among the good. Pity makes the air stifling for all free souls. For the stupidity of the good is unfathomable. To conceal myself and my riches – that did I learn down there: for I found everybody still poor in spirit. It was my pity's lie that I knew with everybody, that I saw and scented in everybody what was sufficient spirit for him and what was too much spirit for him! Their pedantic wise men: I called them wise, not pedantic – thus I learned to slur words. Their gravediggers: I called them investigators and scholars – thus I learned to confound words. Gravediggers dig diseases for themselves. Evil vapours repose beneath old rubble. One should not stir up the bog. One should live upon

mountains. With happy nostrils I breathe again mountain-freedom! At last my nose is delivered from the odour of all humankind! My soul, tickled by sharp breezes as with sparkling wine, sneezes – sneezes and cries to itself: Bless you! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Three Evil Things 1 I N a dream, in my last morning dream, I stood today upon a headland – beyond the world, I held a pair of scales and weighed the world. Oh, that the dawn came to me too soon! It glowed me into wakefulness, the jealous dawn! It is always jealous of the glow of my morning dreams. Measurable to him who has time, weighable to a good weigher, accessible to strong pinions, divivable to divine nutcrackers: thus did my dream find the world. My dream, a bold sailor, half ship half hurricane, silent as a butterfly, impatient as a falcon: how did it have time and patience today for weighing of worlds? Did my wisdom perhaps speak secretly to it, my laughing, wakeful day-wisdom that mocks all ‘infinite worlds’? For my wisdom says: ‘Where power is, there number becomes master: it has more power.’ How confidently did my dream gaze upon this finite world, eager neither for new things nor for old; neither in awe nor in supplication – as if a round apple presented itself to my hand, a ripe, golden apple with a soft, cool, velvety skin – thus the world presented itself to me – as if a tree nodded to me, a wide-branching, strong-willed tree, bent for reclining and as a footstool for the way-weary: thus the world stood upon my headland – as if tender hands brought me a casket – a casket open for the delight of modest, adoring eyes: thus the world presented himself before me today – not so enigmatic as to frighten away human love, not so explicit as to put to sleep human wisdom – a good, human thing was the world to me today, this world of which so many evil things are said! How grateful I am to my morning dream, that today in the early morning I thus weighed the world! It came to me as a good, human thing, this dream and comforter of the heart! And that I may do the same as it by day and learn and imitate its best aspects, I will now place the three most evil things upon the scales and weigh them well and humanly. He who taught how to bless also taught how to curse: which are the three most-cursed things in the world? I will place these upon the scales. Sensual pleasure, lust for power, selfishness : these three have hitherto been cursed the most and held in the worst and most unjust repute – these three will I weigh well and humanly. Well then! Here is my headland and there is the sea: it rolls towards me, shaggy, fawning, the faithful old hundred-headed canine monster that I love. Well then! Here I will hold the scales over the rolling sea: and I choose a witness, too, to look on – you, hermit tree, you heavy-odoured, broad-arched tree that I love! Upon what bridge does the present go over to the hereafter? What compulsion compels the high to bend to the low? And what bids even the highest – to grow higher still? Now the scales stand level and still: I have thrown in three weighty questions, the other scale bears three weighty answers. 2 Sensual pleasure: goad and stake to all hair-shirted despisers

of the body and anathematized as ‘the world’ by all afterworldsmen: for it mocks and makes fools of all teachers of confusion and error. Sensual pleasure: to the rabble the slow fire over which they are roasted; to all worm-eaten wood, to all stinking tatters, the ever-ready stewing-oven of lust. Sensual pleasure: innocent and free to free hearts, the earth’s garden-joy, an overflowing of thanks to the present from all the future. Sensual pleasure: a sweet poison only to the withered, but to the lion-willed the great restorative and reverently-preserved wine of wines. Sensual pleasure: the great symbolic happiness of a higher happiness and highest hope. For marriage is promised to many, and more than marriage – to many that are stranger to one another than man and woman: and who has fully conceived how strange man and woman are to one another! Sensual pleasure – but I will fence my thoughts round, and my words too: so that swine and hot fanatics shall not break into my garden! Lust for power: the scourge of fire of the hardest-hearted; the cruel torment reserved by the cruellest for himself; the dark flame of living bonfires. Lust for power: the wicked fly seated upon the vainest peoples; the mocker of all uncertain virtue; which rides upon every horse and every pride. Lust for power: the earthquake that breaks and bursts open all that is decayed and hollow; the rolling, growling, punitive destroyer of whitewashed sepulchres; the flashing question-mark beside premature answers. Lust for power: before its glance man crawls and bends and toils and becomes lower than the swine or the snake – until at last the cry of the great contempt bursts from him – Lust for power: the fearsome teacher of the great contempt, who preaches in the face of cities and empires ‘Away with you!’ – until at last they themselves cry out ‘Away with me !’ Lust for power: which, however, rises enticingly even to the pure and the solitary and up to self-sufficient heights, glowing like a love that paints purple delights enticingly on earthly heavens. Lust for power: but who shall call it lust , when the height longs to stoop down after power I Truly, there is no sickness and lust in such a longing and descent! That the lonely height may not always be solitary and sufficient to itself; that the mountain may descend to the valley and the wind of the heights to the lowlands – Oh who shall find the rightful baptismal and virtuous name for such a longing! ‘Bestowing virtue’ – that is the name Zarathustra once gave the unnameable. And then it also happened – and truly, it happened for the first time! – that his teaching glorified selfishness , the sound, healthy selfishness that issues from a mighty soul – from a mighty soul, to which pertains the exalted body, the beautiful, victorious, refreshing body, around which everything becomes a mirror; the supple, persuasive body, the dancer whose image and epitome is the self-rejoicing soul. The self-rejoicing of such bodies and souls calls itself: ‘Virtue’. Such self-rejoicing protects itself with its doctrines of good and bad as with sacred groves; with the names it gives its happiness it banishes from itself all that is contemptible. It banishes from itself all that is cowardly; it says: Bad – that is to

say, cowardly! He who is always worrying, sighing, complaining, and who gleans even the smallest advantage, seems contemptible to it. It also despises all woeful wisdom: for truly, there is also a wisdom that blossoms in darkness, a night-shade wisdom, which is always sighing: 'All is vain!' Timid mistrustfulness seems base to it, as do all who desire oaths instead of looks and hands; and all-too-mistrustful wisdom, for such is the nature of cowardly souls. It regards as baser yet him who is quick to please, who, dog-like, lies upon his back, the humble man; and there is also a wisdom that is humble and dog-like and pious and quick to please. Entirely hateful and loathsome to it is he who will never defend himself, who swallows down poisonous spittle and evil looks, the too-patient man who puts up with everything, is content with everything: for that is the nature of slaves. Whether one be servile before gods and divine kicks, or before men and the silly opinions of men: it spits at skies of all kinds, this glorious selfishness! Bad: that is what it calls all that is broken-down and niggardly-servile, unclear, blinking eyes, oppressed hearts, and that false, yielding type of man who kisses with broad, cowardly lips. And sham-wisdom: that is what it calls all wit that slaves and old men and weary men affect; and especially the whole bad, raving, over-clever priest-foolishness! And to ill-use selfishness – precisely that has been virtue and called virtue. And 'selfless' – that is what, with good reason, all these world-weary cowards and Cross-spiders wished to be! But now the day, the transformation, the sword of judgement, the great noontide comes to them all: then many things shall be revealed! And he who declares the Ego healthy and holy and selfishness glorious – truly, he, a prophet, declares too what he knows: 'Behold, it comes, it is near, the great noontide!' Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of the Spirit of Gravity 1 MY glib tongue – is of the people; I speak too coarsely and warmly for silky rabbits. And my words sound even stranger to all inky fish and scribbling foxes. My hand – is a fool's hand: woe to all tables and walls and whatever has room left for fool's scribbling, fool's doodling! My foot – is a horse's foot: with it I trot and trample up hill, down dale, hither and thither over the fields, and am the Devil's own for joy when I am out at a gallop. My stomach – is it perhaps an eagle's stomach? For it likes lamb's flesh best of all. But it is certainly a bird's stomach. Nourished with innocent and few things, ready and impatient to fly, to fly away – that is my nature now: how should there not be something of the bird's nature in it! And especially bird-like is that I am enemy to the Spirit of Gravity: and truly, mortal enemy, arch-enemy, born enemy! Oh where has my enmity not flown and strayed already! I could sing a song about that – and I will sing one, although I am alone in an empty house and have to sing it to my own ears. There are other singers, to be sure, whose voices are softened, whose hands are eloquent, whose eyes are expressive, whose hearts are awakened, only when the house is full: I am not one of them. 2 He who will one day teach men to fly will have moved all boundary-

stones; all boundary-stones will themselves fly into the air to him, he will baptize the earth anew – as ‘the weightless’. The ostrich runs faster than any horse, but even he sticks his head heavily into heavy earth: that is what the man who cannot yet fly is like. He calls earth and life heavy: and so will the Spirit of Gravity have it! But he who wants to become light and a bird must love himself – thus do I teach. Not with the love of the sick and diseased, to be sure: for with them even self-love stinks! One must learn to love oneself with a sound and healthy love, so that one may endure it with oneself and not go roaming about – thus do I teach. Such roaming about calls itself ‘love of one’s neighbour’: these words have been up to now the best for lying and dissembling, and especially for those who were oppressive to everybody. And truly, to learn to love oneself is no commandment for today or for tomorrow. Rather is this art the finest, subtlest, ultimate, and most patient of all. For all his possessions are well concealed from the possessor; and of all treasure pits, one’s own is the last to be digged – the Spirit of Gravity is the cause of that. Almost in the cradle are we presented with heavy words and values: this dowry calls itself ‘Good’ and ‘Evil’. For its sake we are forgiven for being alive. And we suffer little children to come to us, to prevent them in good time from loving themselves: the Spirit of Gravity is the cause of that. And we – we bear loyally what we have been given upon hard shoulders over rugged mountains! And when we sweat we are told: ‘Yes, life is hard to bear!’ But only man is hard to bear! That is because he bears too many foreign things upon his shoulders. Like the camel, he kneels down and lets himself be well laden. Especially the strong, weight-bearing man in whom dwell respect and awe: he has laden too many foreign heavy words and values upon himself – now life seems to him a desert! And truly I Many things that are one’s own are hard to bear, too! And much that is intrinsic in man is like the oyster, that is loathsome and slippery and hard to grasp – so that a noble shell with noble embellishments must intercede for it. But one has to learn this art as well: to have a shell and a fair appearance and a prudent blindness! Again, it is deceptive about many things in man that many a shell is inferior and wretched and too much of a shell. Much hidden goodness and power is never guessed at; the most exquisite dainties find no tasters! Women, or the most exquisite of them, know this: a little fatter, a little thinner – oh, how much fate lies in so little! Man is difficult to discover, most of all to himself; the spirit often tells lies about the soul. The Spirit of Gravity is the cause of that. But he has discovered himself who says: This is my good and evil: he has silenced thereby the mole and dwarf who says: ‘Good for all, evil for all.’ Truly, I dislike also those who call everything good and this world the best of all. I call such people the all-contented. All-contentedness that knows how to taste everything: that is not the best taste! I honour the obstinate, fastidious tongues and stomachs that have learned to say ‘I’ and ‘Yes’ and ‘No’. But to chew and digest everything – that is to have a really swinish nature! Always to say Ye-a 32

– only the ass and those like him have learned that. Deep yellow and burning red: that is to my taste – it mixes blood with all colours. But he who whitewashes his house betrays to me a whitewashed soul. One loves mummies, the other phantoms; and both alike enemy to all flesh and blood – oh, how both offend my taste! For I love blood. And I do not want to stay and dwell where everyone spews and spits: that is now my taste – I would rather live among thieves and perjurers. No one bears gold in his mouth. More offensive to me, however, are all lickspittles; and the most offensive beast of a man I ever found I baptized Parasite: it would not love, yet wanted to live by love. I call wretched all who have only one choice: to become an evil beast or an evil tamer of beasts: I would build no tabernacles among these men. I also call wretched those who always have to wait – they offend my taste: all tax-collectors and shopkeepers and kings and other keepers of lands and shops. Truly, I too have learned to wait, I have learned it from the very heart, but only to wait for myself. And above all I have learned to stand and to walk and to run and to jump and to climb and to dance. This, however, is my teaching: He who wants to learn to fly one day must first learn to stand and to walk and to run and to climb and to dance – you cannot learn to fly by flying! With rope-ladders I learned to climb to many a window, with agile legs I climbed up high masts: to sit upon high masts of knowledge seemed to me no small happiness – to flicker like little flames upon high masts: a little light, to be sure, but yet a great comfort to castaway sailors and the shipwrecked! I came to my truth by diverse paths and in diverse ways: it was not upon a single ladder that I climbed to the height where my eyes survey my distances. And I have asked the way only unwillingly – that has always offended my taste! I have rather questioned and attempted the ways themselves. All my progress has been an attempting and a questioning – and truly, one has to learn how to answer such questioning! That however – is to my taste: not good taste, not bad taste, but my taste, which I no longer conceal and of which I am no longer ashamed. ‘This – is now my way: where is yours?’ Thus I answered those who asked me ‘the way’. For the way – does not exist! Thus spoke Zarathustra. Of Old and New Law – Tables 1 H E R E I sit and wait, old shattered law-tables around me and also new, half-written law-tables. When will my hour come? – the hour of my down-going, my descent: for I want to go to men once more. For that I now wait: for first the sign that it is my hour must come to me – namely, the laughing lion with the flock of doves. Meanwhile I talk to myself, as one who has plenty of time. No one tells me anything new; so I tell myself to myself. 2 When I visited men, I found them sitting upon an old self-conceit. Each one thought he had long since known what was good and evil for man. All talk of virtue seemed to them an ancient wearied affair; and he who wished to sleep well spoke of ‘good’ and ‘evil’ before retiring. I disturbed this somnolence when I taught that nobody yet knows what is good and evil – unless it be the creator!

But he it is who creates a goal for mankind and gives the earth its meaning and its future: he it is who creates the quality of good and evil in things. And I bade them overturn their old professorial chairs, and wherever that old self-conceit had sat. I bade them laugh at their great masters of virtue and saints and poets and world-redeemers. I bade them laugh at their gloomy sages, and whoever had sat as a black scarecrow, cautioning, on the tree of life. I sat myself on their great grave-street, and even beside carrion and vultures – and I laughed over all their ‘past’ and its decayed expiring glory. Truly, like Lenten preachers and fools did I cry anger and shame over all their great and small things – their best is so very small! Their worst is so very small! – thus I laughed. Thus from out of me cried and laughed my wise desire, which was born on the mountains, a wild wisdom, in truth! – my great desire with rushing wings. And often it tore me forth and up and away and in the midst of laughter: and then indeed I flew, an arrow, quivering with sun-intoxicated rapture: out into the distant future, which no dream has yet seen, into warmer Souths than artists have ever dreamed of, there where gods, dancing, are ashamed of all clothes – so that I might speak in parables, and hobble and stutter like poets: and truly, I am ashamed that I still have to be a poet! Where all becoming seemed to me the dancing of gods and the wantonness of gods, and the world unrestrained and abandoned and fleeing back to itself – as many gods eternally fleeing and re-seeking one another, as many gods blissfully self-contradicting, communing again and belonging again to one another – Where all time seemed to me a blissful mockery of moments, where necessity was freedom itself, which blissfully played with the goad of freedom – Where I found again my old devil and arch-enemy, the Spirit of Gravity, and all that he created: compulsion, dogma, need and consequence and purpose and will and good and evil: For must there not exist that which is danced upon, danced across? Must there not be moles and heavy dwarfs – for the sake of the nimble, the nimblest? 3 There it was too that I picked up the word ‘Superman’ and that man is something that must be overcome, that man is a bridge and not a goal; counting himself happy for his noontides and evenings, as a way to new dawns: Zarathustra’s saying of the great noontide, and what ever else I have hung up over men, like a purple evening afterglow. Truly, I showed them new stars, together with new nights – and over cloud and day and night I spread out laughter like a coloured canopy. I taught them all my art and aims: to compose into one and bring together what is fragment and riddle and dreadful chance in man – as poet, reader of riddles, and redeemer of chance, I taught them to create the future, and to redeem by creating – all that was past. To redeem that past of mankind and to transform every ‘It was’, until the will says: ‘But I willed it thus! So shall I will it-’ this did I call redemption, this alone did I teach them to call redemption. Now I await my redemption – that I may go to them for the last time. For I want to go to man once more: I want to go under among them, I want

to give them, dying, my richest gift! From the sun when it goes down, that superabundant star, I learned this: then, from inexhaustible riches it pours out gold into the sea – so that the poorest fisherman rows with golden oars! For once I saw this, and did not tire of weeping to see it. Like the sun, Zarathustra also wants to go down: now he sits here and waits, old shattered law-tables around him and also new law-tables – half-written. 4 Behold, here is a new law-table: but where are my brothers, to bear it with me to the valley and to fleshly hearts? Thus commands my great love for the most distant men: Do not spare your neighbour! Man is something that must be overcome. There are diverse paths and ways to overcoming: just look to it! But only a buffoon thinks: ‘Man can also jumped over’. Overcome yourself even in your neighbour: and a right that you can seize for yourself you should not accept as a gift! What you do, no one can do to you. Behold, there is no requital. He who cannot command himself should obey. And many a one can command himself but be very remiss in obeying what he commands! 5 This is the will of those of noble soul: they desire nothing gratis, least of all life. He who is of the mob wants to live gratis; we others, however, to whom life has given itself- we are always considering what we can best give in return! And truly, it is a noble speech that says: ‘What life has promised us, we shall keep that promise – to life!’ One should not wish to enjoy where one has not given enjoyment. And – one should not wish to enjoy! For enjoyment and innocence are the most modest things: neither want to be looked for. One should have them – but one should look rather for guilt and pain! 6 O my brothers, he who is a first-born is always sacrificed. Now we are first-born. We all bleed at secret sacrificial tables, we all burn and roast to the honour of ancient idols. Our best is still young: this excites old palates. Our flesh is tender, our skin is only a lamb-skin: – how should we not excite old idol-priests! He still lives on in us ourselves, the old idol-priest, who roasts our best for his feast. Alas, my brothers, how should the firstborn not be sacrifices! But our kind will have it thus; and I love those who do not wish to preserve themselves. I love with my whole love those who go down and perish: for they are going beyond. 7 To be truthful – few can do it! And those who can, will not! Least of all, however, can the good be truthful. Oh these good men! Good men never tell the truth; to be good in that way is a sickness of the spirit. They yield, these good men, they acquiesce, their hearts imitate, they obey from the heart: but he who obeys does not listen to himself! All that the good call evil must come together that one truth may be born: O my brothers, are you, too, evil enough for this truth? The bold attempt, prolonged mistrust, the cruel No, satiety, the cutting into the living – how seldom do these come together! But from such seed is – truth raised. Hitherto all knowledge has grown up beside the bad conscience! Shatter, you enlightened men, shatter the old law-tables! 8 When water is planked over so that it can be walked upon, when gangway and railings span the stream: truly, he is

not believed who says: 'Everything is in flux.' 33 On the contrary, even simpletons contradict him. 'What?' say the simpletons, 'everything in flux? But there are planks and railings over the stream! 'Over the stream everything is firmly fixed, all the values of things, the bridges, concepts, all "Good" and "Evil": all are firmly fixed !' But when hard winter comes, the animal-tamer of streams, then even the cleverest learn mistrust; and truly, not only the simpletons say then: 'Is not everything meant to – stand still?' 'Fundamentally, everything stands still' – that is a proper winter doctrine, a fine thing for unfruitful seasons, a fine consolation for hibernators and stay at-homes. 'Fundamentally, everything stands still' – the thawing wind, however, preaches to the contrary! The thawing wind, an ox that is no ploughing ox – a raging ox, a destroyer that breaks ice with its angry horns! Ice, however – breaks gangways! O my brothers, is everything not now in flux? Have not all railings and gangways fallen into the water and come to nothing? Who can still cling to 'good' and 'evil'? 'Woe to us! Hail to us! The thawing wind is blowing!' – Preach thus, O my brothers, through every street! 9 There is an old delusion that is called good and evil. Up to now, this delusion has orbited about prophets and astrologers. Once people believed in prophets and astrologers: and therefore people believed: 'Everything is fate: you shall, for you must!' Then again people mistrusted all prophets and astrologers: and therefore people believed: 'Everything is freedom: you can, for you will!' O my brothers, up to now there has been only supposition, not knowledge, concerning the stars and the future: and therefore there has hitherto been only supposition, not knowledge, concerning good and evil! 10 'You shall not steal! You shall not kill!' – such words were once called holy; in their presence people bowed their knees and their heads and removed their shoes. But I ask you: Where have there ever been better thieves and killers in the world than such holy words have been? Is there not in all life itself- stealing and killing? And when such words were called holy was not truth itself – killed? Or was it a sermon of death that called holy that which contradicted and opposed all life? – O my brothers, shatter, shatter the old law-tables! 11 My pity for all that is past is that I see: It has been handed over – handed over to the favour, the spirit, the madness of every generation that comes and transforms everything that has been into its own bridge! A great despot could come, a shrewd devil, who with his favour and disfavour could compel and constrain all that is past, until it became his bridge and prognostic and herald and cock-crow. This, however, is the other danger and my other pity: he who is of the mob remembers back to his grandfather – with his grandfather, however, time stops. Thus all that is past is handed over: for the mob could one day become master, and all time be drowned in shallow waters. Therefore, O my brothers, is a new nobility needed: to oppose all mob-rule and all despotism and to write anew upon new law-tables the word: 'Noble'. For many noblemen are needed, and noblemen of many kinds, for nobility to exist !

Or, as I once said in a parable: ‘Precisely this is godliness, that there are gods but no God!’ 12 O my brothers, I direct and consecrate you to a new nobility: you shall become begetters and cultivators and sowers of the future – truly, not to a nobility that you could buy like shopkeepers with shopkeepers’ gold: for all that has a price is of little value. Let where you are going, not where you come from, henceforth be your honour I Your will and your foot that desires to step out beyond you – let them be your new honour! Truly, not that you have served a prince – of what account are princes now! – or have become a bulwark to that which stands, that it may stand more firmly! Not that your family have grown courtly at courts and you have learned to stand for long hours in shallow pools, motley-coloured like a flamingo: for being able to stand is a merit with courtiers; and all courtiers believe that part of the bliss after death is – being allowed to sit! And not that a ghost, called holy, led your ancestors into promised lands that I do not praise: for in the land where the worst of all trees, the Cross, grew – there is nothing to praise! – and truly, wherever this ‘Holy Ghost’ led its knights, goats and geese and Cross-eyed and wrong-headed fellows always – ran at the head of the procession! O my brothers, your nobility shall not gaze backward, but outward ! You shall be fugitives from all fatherlands and fore-fatherlands! You shall love your children’s land : let this love be your new nobility – the undiscovered land in the furthest sea! I bid your sails seek it and seek it! You shall make amends to your children for being the children of your fathers: thus you shall redeem all that is past I This new law-table do I put over you! 13 ‘Wherefore live? All is vanity! To live – that means to thrash straw; to live – that means to burn oneself and yet not become warm.’ Ancient rigmarole like this still counts as ‘wisdom’; and it is the more honoured because it is old and smells damp. Even mould ennobles. Children might speak in this way: they shrink from the fire because it has burned them! There is much childishness in the old books of wisdom. And how should he who is always ‘thrashing straw’ be allowed to slander thrashing! Such a fool would have to have his mouth stopped! Such people sit down to dinner and bring nothing with them, not even a good appetite – and now they say slanderously: ‘All is vanity!’ But to eat and drink well, O my brothers, is truly no vain art! Shatter, shatter the law-tables of the never-joyful! 14 ‘To the pure all things are pure’ – thus speaks the people. But I say to you: To the swine all things become swinish! That is why the fanatics and hypocrites with bowed heads whose hearts too are bowed down preach: ‘The world itself is a filthy monster.’ For they all have an unclean spirit; but especially those who have no peace or rest except they see the world from behind – these afterworldsmen! I tell these to their faces, although it does not sound pleasant: The world resembles man in that it has a behind – so much is true! There is much filth in the world: so much is true! But the world itself is not yet a filthy monster on that account! There is wisdom in the fact that much in the world smells ill:

disgust itself creates wings and water-divining powers! Even in the best there is something to excite disgust; and even the best is something that must be overcome! O my brothers, there is much wisdom in the fact that there is much filth in the world! 15 These sayings I heard pious afterworldsmen say to their consciences, and truly without deceit or falsehood, although there is nothing more false or deceitful in the world. ‘Let the world be! Do not raise even a finger against it!’ ‘Let him who wants to slaughter and kill and harass and swindle the people: do not raise even a finger against it! Thus they will yet learn to renounce the world.’ ‘And your own reason – you shall yourself choke and throttle; for it is a reason of this world – thus you shall yourself learn to renounce the world.’ Shatter, O my brothers, shatter these ancient law-tables of the pious! Shatter by your teachings the sayings of the world-calumniators! 16 ‘He who learns much, unlearns all violent desiring’ – people whisper that to one another today in all dark streets. ‘Wisdom makes weary, nothing is worth while; you shall not desire!’ – I found this new law-table hanging even in public market-places. Shatter, O my brothers, shatter this new law-table too! The world-weary and the preachers of death hung it up, and so did the jailers: for behold, it is also a sermon urging slavery: They have learned badly and the best things not at all, they have learned everything too early and too fast: they have eaten badly – that is how they got that stomach-ache – for their spirit is stomach-ache: it counsels death! For truly, my brothers, the spirit is a stomach! Life is a fountain of delight: but all wells are poisoned for him from whom an aching stomach, the father of affliction, speaks. To know: that is delight to the lion-willed! But he who has grown weary is only ‘willed’, he is the sport of every wave. And that is always the nature of weak men: they lose themselves on their way. And at last their weariness asks: ‘Why have we ever taken any way? It is a matter of indifference!’ It sounds pleasant to their ears when it is preached: ‘Nothing is worth while! You shall not will!’ This, however, is a sermon urging slavery. O my brothers, Zarathustra comes as a fresh, blustering wind to all the way-weary; he will yet make many noses sneeze! My liberal breath blows even through walls and into prisons and imprisoned spirits! Willing liberates: for willing is creating: thus I teach. And you should learn only for creating! And you should first learn from me even how to learn, how to learn well! – He who has ears to hear, let him hear! 17 There stands the boat – over there is perhaps the way to the great Nothingness. But who wants to step into this ‘perhaps’? None of you wants to step into the death-boat! How then could you be world-weary? World-weary! And you have not yet even parted from the earth!! have always found you still greedy for the earth, still in love with your own weariness of the earth! Your lip does not hang down in vain – a little earthly wish still sits upon it I And in your eye – does not a little cloud of unforgotten earthly joy swim there? There are many excellent inventions on earth, some useful, some pleasant: the earth is to be

loved for their sake. And there are many things so well devised that they are like women's breasts: at the same time useful and pleasant. But you world-weary people! You should be given a stroke of the cane! Your legs should be made sprightly again with cane-strokes! For: if you are not invalids and worn-out wretches of whom the earth is weary, you are sly sluggards or dainty, sneaking lust-cats. And if you will not again run about merrily, you shall – pass away! One should not want to be physician to the incurable: thus Zarathustra teaches: so you shall pass away! But to make an end requires more courage than to make a new verse: all physicians and poets know that. 18 O my brothers, there are law-tables framed by weariness and law-tables framed by laziness, indolent laziness: although they speak similarly they want to be heard differently. Look here at this languishing man! He is only an inch from his goal, but from weariness he has laid himself defiantly here in the dust: this valiant man! He yawns from weariness at the path and the earth and the goal and at himself: he refuses to take another step – this valiant man! Now the sun burns down upon him and the dogs lick his sweat: but he lies there in his defiance and prefers to languish – to languish an inch from his goal! Truly, he will have to be pulled into his heaven by the hair – this hero! Better to leave him lying where he has laid himself, so that sleep, the comforter, may come to him with cooling, murmuring rain: Let him lie until he awakes of his own accord, until of his own accord he disavows all weariness and what weariness has taught through him! Only, my brothers, scare away the dogs from him, the indolent skulkers, and all the swarming vermin – all the swarming 'cultured' vermin who feast upon the sweat of every hero! 19 I form circles and holy boundaries around myself; fewer and fewer climb with me upon higher and higher mountains: I build a mountain-range out of holier and holier mountains. But wherever you would climb with me, O my brothers, see to it that we parasite climbs with you! Parasite: that is a worm, a creeping, supple worm, that wants to grow fat on your sick, sore places. And it is its art to divine the weary spots in climbing souls: it builds its loathsome nest in your grief and dejection, in your tender modesty. Where the strong man is weak, where the noble man is too gentle, there it builds its loathsome nest: the parasite dwells where the great man possesses little sore places. Which is the highest type of being and which the lowest? The parasite is the lowest type; but he who is of the highest type nourishes the most parasites. For the soul which possesses the longest ladder and can descend the deepest: how should the most parasites not sit upon it? the most spacious soul, which can run and stray and roam the farthest into itself; the most necessary soul, which out of joy hurls itself into chance – the existing soul which plunges into becoming; the possessing soul which wants to partake in desire and longing – the soul fleeing from itself which retrieves itself in the widest sphere; the wisest soul, to which foolishness speaks sweetest – the soul that loves itself the most, in which all things have their current and counter-

current and ebb and flow: – oh how should the highest soul not possess the worst parasites? 20 O my brothers, am I then cruel? But I say: That which is falling should also be pushed! Everything of today – it is falling, it is decaying: who would support it? But I – want to push it too! Do you know the delight that rolls stones into precipitous depths? – These men of today: just see how they roll into my depths! I am a prologue to better players, O my brothers! An example! 34 Follow my example! And him you do not teach to fly, teach – to fall faster! 21 I love the brave: but it is not enough to be a swordsman, one must also know against whom to be a swordsman! And there is often more bravery in containing oneself and passing by: in order to spare oneself for a worthier enemy! You should have enemies whom you hate but not enemies whom you despise: you must be proud of your enemy: thus I taught once before. You should spare yourselves, O my friends, for a worthier enemy: therefore you must pass many things by, especially must you pass by many of the rabble who din in your ears about people and peoples. Keep your eye clear of their For and Against! There is much right, much wrong in it: whoever looks on grows angry. To look in, to weigh in – that comes to the same thing in this case: therefore go off into the forests and lay your sword to sleep! Go your ways! And let people and peoples go theirs! – dark ways, to be sure, on which not one hope lightens any longer! Let the shopkeeper rule where everything that still glisters is – shopkeeper’s gold! The age of kings is past: what today calls itself the people deserves no king. Just see how these people themselves now behave like shopkeepers: they glean the smallest advantage from sweepings of every kind. They lie in wait for one another, they wheedle things out of one another – they call that ‘good neighbourliness’. Oh blessed, distant time when a people said to itself: ‘I want to be – master over peoples!’ For, my brothers: the best shall rule, the best wants to rule! And where it is taught differently, there – the best is lacking. 22 If they – had bread for nothing, alas! – what would they cry for! Their maintenance – that is their proper entertainment; 35 and life shall be hard for them! They are beasts of prey: even in their ‘working’ – there is robbery, even in their ‘earning’ – there is fraud! Therefore life shall be hard for them! Thus they shall become finer beasts of prey, subtler, cleverer, more man-like beasts of prey: for man is the finest beast of prey. Man has already robbed all beasts of their virtues: that is why, of all beasts, life is the hardest for man. Only the birds are still beyond him. And if man should learn to fly, alas I to what height – would his rapaciousness fly! 23 This is how I would have man and woman: the one fit for war, the other fit for bearing children, but both fit for dancing with head and heels. And let that day be lost to us on which we did not dance once! And let that wisdom be false to us that brought no laughter with it! 24 Your marriage-contracting: see it is not a bad contracting . You have decided too quickly: from that follows – break up of marriage. 36 And yet rather break up of marriage than bending of marriage, lying

in marriage! – A woman said to me: ‘True, I broke up my marriage, but first my marriage – broke me up!’ I have always found the badly-paired to be the most revengeful: they make everybody suffer for the fact that they are no longer single. For that reason I want honest people to say to one another: ‘We love each other: let us see to it that we stay in love! Or shall our promise be a mistake? 37 ‘Allow us a term and a little marriage, to see if we are fit for the great marriage! It is a big thing always to be with another!’ Thus I counsel all honest people; and what would be my love for the Superman and for everything to come if I should counsel and speak otherwise! To propagate yourselves, not only forward but upward – may the garden of marriage assist you, O my brothers! 25 He who has grown wise concerning old origins, behold, he will at last seek new springs of the future and new origins. O my brothers, it will not be long before new peoples shall arise and new springs rush down into new depths. For the earthquake – that blocks many wells and causes much thirst – also brings to light inner powers and secret things. The earthquake reveals new springs. In the earthquake of ancient peoples new springs break forth. And around him who cries: ‘Behold here a well for many who are thirsty, one heart for many who long, one will for many instruments’ – around him assembles a people, that is to say: many experimenters. Who can command, who can obey – that is experimented here! Alas, with what protracted searching and succeeding, and failing and learning and experimenting anew! Human society: that is an experiment, so I teach – a long search: 38 it seeks, however, the commander! – an experiment, O my brothers I And not a ‘contract’ I Shatter, shatter that expression of the soft-hearted and half-and-half! 26 O my brothers! With whom does the greatest danger for the whole human future lie? Is it not with the good and just?– with those who say and feel in their hearts: ‘We already know what is good and just, we possess it too; woe to those who are still searching for it!’ And whatever harm the wicked may do, the harm the good do is the most harmful harm! And whatever harm the world-calumniators may do, the harm the good do is the most harmful harm. O my brothers, someone who once looked into the heart of the good and just said: ‘They are the Pharisees.’ But he was not understood. The good and just themselves could not understand him: their spirit is imprisoned in their good conscience. The stupidity of the good is unfathomably clever. But it is the truth: the good have to be Pharisees – they have no choice! The good have to crucify him who devises his own virtue! That is the truth! But the second man to discover their country, the country, heart, and soil of the good and just, was he who asked: ‘Whom do they hate the most?’ They hate the creator most: him who breaks the law-tables and the old values, the breaker – they call him the law-breaker. For the good – cannot create: they are always the beginning of the end:– they crucify him who writes new values on new law-tables, they sacrifice the future to themselves – they crucify the whole human future! The good – have

always been the beginning of the end. 27 O my brothers, have you understood this saying, too? And what I once said about the 'Ultimate Man'? With whom does the greatest danger to the whole human future lie? Is it not with the good and just? Shatter, shatter the good and just! – O my brothers, have you understood this saying, too? 28 Do you flee from me? Are you frightened? Do you tremble at this saying? O my brothers, when I bade you shatter the good and the law-tables of the good, only then did I embark mankind upon its high seas. And only now does the great terror, the great prospect, the great sickness, the great disgust, the great sea-sickness come to it. The good taught you false shores and false securities; you were born and kept in the lies of the good. Everything has been distorted and twisted down to its very bottom through the good. But he who discovered the country of 'Man', also discovered the country of 'Human Future'. Now you shall be seafarers, brave, patient seafarers! Stand up straight in good time, O my brothers, learn to stand up straight! The sea is stormy: many want to straighten themselves again by your aid. The sea is stormy: everything is at sea. Well then! Come on, you old seaman-hearts! What of fatherland! Our helm wants to fare away, out to where our children's land is! Out, away, more stormy than the sea, storms our great longing! 29 'Why so hard?' the charcoal once said to the diamond; 'for are we not close relations?' Why so soft? O my brothers, thus I ask you: for are you not – my brothers? Why so soft, so unresisting and yielding? Why is there so much denial and abnegation in your hearts? So little fate in your glances? And if you will not be fates, if you will not be inexorable: how can you – conquer with me? And if your hardness will not flash and cut and cut to pieces: how can you one day – create with me? For creators are hard. And it must seem bliss to you to press your hand upon millennia as upon wax, bliss to write upon the will of millennia as upon metal – harder than metal, nobler than metal. Only the noblest is perfectly hard. This new law-table do I put over you, O my brothers: Become hard! 30 O my Will! My essential, my necessity, dispeller of need! Preserve me from all petty victories! O my soul's predestination, which I call destiny! In-me! Over-me! Preserve and spare me for a great destiny! And your last greatness, my Will, save for your last – that you may be inexorable in your victory! Ah, who has not succumbed to his own victory! Ah, whose eye has not dimmed in this intoxicated twilight! Ah, whose foot has not stumbled and in victory forgotten – how to stand! That I may one day be ready and ripe in the great noontide: ready and ripe like glowing ore, like cloud heavy with lightning and like swelling milk-udder – ready for myself and my most secret Will: a bow eager for its arrow, an arrow eager for its star – a star, ready and ripe in its noontide, glowing, transpierced, blissful through annihilating sun-arrows – a sun itself and an inexorable sun-will, ready for annihilation in victory! O Will, my essential, my necessity, dispeller of need! Spare me for one great victory! Thus spoke Zarathustra. The Convalescent 1 O

NE morning, not long after his return to the cave, Zarathustra sprang up from his bed like a madman, cried with a terrible voice, and behaved as if someone else were lying on the bed and would not rise from it; and Zarathustra's voice rang out in such a way that his animals came to him in terror and from all the caves and hiding-places in the neighbourhood of Zarathustra's cave all the creatures slipped away, flying, fluttering, creeping, jumping, according to the kind of foot or wing each had been given. Zarathustra, however, spoke these words: Up, abysmal thought, up from my depths! I am your cockerel and dawn, sleepy worm: up! up! My voice shall soon crow you awake! Loosen the fetters of your ears: listen! For I want to hear you! Up! Up! Here is thunder enough to make even the graves listen! And wipe the sleep and all the dimness and blindness from your eyes! Hear me with your eyes, too: my voice is a medicine even for those born blind. And once you are awake you shall stay awake for ever. It is not my way to awaken great-grandmothers from sleep in order to bid them – go back to sleep! 39 Are you moving, stretching, rattling? Up! Up! You shall not rattle, you shall – speak to me! Zarathustra the Godless calls you! I, Zarathustra, the advocate of life, the advocate of suffering, the advocate of the circle – I call you, my most abysmal thought! Ah! you are coming – I hear you! My abyss speaks, I have turned my ultimate depth into the light! Ah! Come here! Give me your hand – ha! don't! Ha, ha! – Disgust, disgust, disgust – woe is me! 2 Hardly had Zarathustra spoken these words, however, when he fell down like a dead man and remained like a dead man for a long time. But when he again came to himself, he was pale and trembling and remained lying down and for a long time would neither eat nor drink. This condition lasted seven days; his animals, however, did not leave him by day or night, except that the eagle flew off to fetch food. And whatever he had collected and fetched he laid upon Zarathustra's bed: so that at last Zarathustra lay among yellow and red berries, grapes, rosy apples, sweet-smelling herbs and pine-cones. At his feet, however, two lambs were spread, which the eagle had, with difficulty, carried off from their shepherd. At last, after seven days, Zarathustra raised himself in his bed, took a rosy apple in his hand, smelt it, and found its odour pleasant. Then his animals thought the time had come to speak with him. 'O Zarathustra,' they said, 'now you have lain like that seven days, with heavy eyes: will you not now get to your feet again? 'Step out of your cave: the world awaits you like a garden. The wind is laden with heavy fragrance that longs for you; and all the brooks would like to run after you. 'All things long for you, since you have been alone seven days – step out of your cave! All things want to be your physicians! 'Has perhaps a new knowledge come to you, a bitter, oppressive knowledge? You have lain like leavened dough, your soul has risen and overflowed its brim.' 'O my animals,' answered Zarathustra, 'go on talking and let me listen! Your talking is such refreshment: where there is talking, the world is like a garden to me. How sweet it is, that

words and sounds of music exist: are words and music not rainbows and seeming bridges between things eternally separated? ‘Every soul is a world of its own; for every soul every other soul is an afterworld. ‘Appearance lies most beautifully among the most alike; for the smallest gap is the most difficult to bridge. ‘For me – how could there be an outside-of-me? There is no outside! But we forget that, when we hear music; how sweet it is, that we forget! ‘Are things not given names and musical sounds, so that man may refresh himself with things? Speech is a beautiful foolery: with it man dances over all things. ‘How sweet is all speech and all the falsehoods of music! With music does our love dance upon many-coloured rainbows.’ ‘O Zarathustra,’ said the animals then, ‘all things themselves dance for such as think as we: they come and offer their hand and laugh and flee – and return. ‘Everything goes, everything returns; the wheel of existence rolls for ever. Everything dies, everything blossoms anew; the year of existence runs on for ever. ‘Everything breaks, everything is joined anew; the same house of existence builds itself for ever. Everything departs, everything meets again; the ring of existence is true to itself for ever. ‘Existence begins in every instant; the ball There rolls around every Here. The middle is everywhere. The path of eternity is crooked.’ ‘O you buffoons and barrel-organs!’ answered Zarathustra and smiled again; ‘how well you know what had to be fulfilled in seven days: ‘and how that monster crept into my throat and choked me! But I bit its head off and spat it away. ‘And you – have already made a hurdy-gurdy song of it? I, however, lie here now, still weary from this biting and spitting away, still sick with my own redemption. ‘And you looked on at it all? O my animals, are you, too, cruel? Did you desire to be spectators of my great pain, as men do? For man is the cruellest animal. ‘More than anything on earth he enjoys tragedies, bullfights, and crucifixions; and when he invented Hell for himself, behold, it was his heaven on earth. ‘When the great man cries out, straightway the little man comes running; his tongue is hanging from his mouth with lasciviousness. He, however, calls it his “pity”. ‘The little man, especially the poet – how zealously he accuses life in words! Listen to it, but do not overlook the delight that is in all accusation! ‘Such accusers of life: life overcomes them with a glance of its eye. “Do you love me?” it says impudently; “just wait a little, I have no time for you yet.” ‘Man is the cruellest animal towards himself; and with all who call themselves “sinners” and “bearers of the Cross” and “penitents” do not overlook the sensual pleasure that is in this complaint and accusation! ‘And I myself- do I want to be the accuser of man? Ah, my animals, this alone have I learned, that the wickedest in man is necessary for the best in him, ‘that all that is most wicked in him is his best strength and the hardest stone for the highest creator; and that man must grow better and wicked: ‘To know: Man is wicked; that was to be tied to no torture-stake – but I cried as no one had cried before: “Alas, that his wickedest is so very small! Alas, that his best is so very small!”

‘The great disgust at man – it choked me and had crept into my throat: and what the prophet prophesied: “It is all one, nothing is worth while, knowledge chokes.” ‘A long twilight limps in front of me, a mortally-weary, death-intoxicated sadness which speaks with a yawn. ““The man of whom you are weary, the little man, recurs eternally” – thus my sadness yawned and dragged its feet and could not fall asleep. ‘The human earth became to me a cave, its chest caved in, everything living became to me human decay and bones and mouldering past. ‘My sighs sat upon all the graves of man and could no longer rise; my sighs and questions croaked and choked and gnawed and wailed by day and night: ““Alas, man recurs eternally! The little man recurs eternally!” ‘I had seen them both naked, the greatest man and the smallest man: all too similar to one another, even the greatest all too human! ‘The greatest all too small! – that was my disgust at man I And eternal recurrence even for the smallest! that was my disgust at all existence! ‘Ah, disgust! Disgust! Disgust!’ Thus spoke Zarathustra and sighed and shuddered; for he remembered his sickness. But his animals would not let him speak further. ‘Speak no further, convalescent!’ – thus his animals answered him, ‘but go out to where the world awaits you like a garden. ‘Go out to the roses and bees and flocks of doves! But go out especially to the song-birds, so that you may learn singing from them! ‘For convalescents should sing; let the healthy talk. And when the healthy man, too, desires song, he desires other songs than the convalescent.’ ‘O you buffoons and barrel-organs, do be quiet!’ answered Zarathustra and smiled at his animals. ‘How well you know what comfort I devised for myself in seven days! ‘That I have to sing again – that comfort and this convalescence did I devise for myself: do you want to make another hurdy-gurdy song out of that, too?’ ‘Speak no further,’ his animals answered once more; ‘rather first prepare yourself a lyre, convalescent, a new lyre! ‘For behold, O Zarathustra! New lyres are needed for your new songs. ‘Sing and bubble over, O Zarathustra, heal your soul with new songs, so that you may bear your great destiny, that was never yet the destiny of any man! ‘For your animals well know, O Zarathustra, who you are and must become: behold, you are the teacher of the eternal recurrence , that is now your destiny! ‘That you have to be the first to teach this doctrine – how should this great destiny not also be your greatest danger and sickness! ‘Behold, we know what you teach: that all things recur eternally and we ourselves with them, and that we have already existed an infinite number of times before and all things with us. ‘You teach that there is a great year of becoming, a colossus of a year: this year must, like an hour-glass, turn itself over again and again, so that it may run down and run out anew: ‘so that all these years resemble one another, in the greatest things and in the smallest, so that we ourselves resemble ourselves in each great year, in the greatest things and in the smallest. ‘And if you should die now, O Zarathustra: behold, we know too what you would then say to yourself – but your animals ask

you not to die yet! ‘You would say – and without trembling, but rather gasping for happiness: for a great weight and oppression would have been lifted from you, most patient of men! “Now I die and decay,” you would say, “and in an instant I shall be nothingness. Souls are as mortal as bodies. “But the complex of causes in which I am entangled will recur – it will create me again! I myself am part of these causes of the eternal recurrence. “I shall return, with this sun, with this earth, with this eagle, with this serpent – not to a new life or a better life or a similar life: “I shall return eternally to this identical and self-same life, in the greatest things and in the smallest, to teach once more the eternal recurrence of all things, “to speak once more the teaching of the great noontide of earth and man, to tell man of the Superman once more. “I spoke my teaching, I broke upon my teaching: thus my eternal fate will have it – as prophet do I perish! “Now the hour has come when he who is going down shall bless himself. Thus – ends Zarathustra’s down-going.”’ When the animals had spoken these words they fell silent and expected that Zarathustra would say something to them: but Zarathustra did not hear that they were silent. On the contrary, he lay still with closed eyes like a sleeper, although he was not asleep: for he was conversing with his soul. The serpent and the eagle, however, when they found him thus silent, respected the great stillness around him and discreetly withdrew. Of the Great Longing O MY soul, I taught you to say ‘today’ as well as ‘once’ and ‘formerly’ and to dance your dance over every Here and There and Over-there. O my soul, I rescued you from all corners, I brushed dust, spiders, and twilight away from you. O my soul, I washed the petty shame and corner-virtue away from you and persuaded you to stand naked before the eyes of the sun. With the storm which is called ‘spirit’ I blew across your surging sea; I blew all clouds away, I killed even that killer-bird 40 called ‘sin’. O my soul, I gave you the right to say No like the storm and to say Yes as the open sky says Yes: now, silent as light you stand, and you pass through denying storms. O my soul, I gave you back freedom over created and uncreated things: and who knows as you know the delight of things to come? O my soul, I taught you contempt that comes not as the gnawing of a worm, the great, the loving contempt which loves most where it despises most. O my soul, I taught you so to persuade that you persuade the elements themselves to come to you: like the sun that persuades the sea to rise even to its height. O my soul, I took from you all obeying, knee-bending, and obsequiousness; I myself gave you the names ‘Dispeller of Care’ and ‘Destiny’. O my soul, I gave you new names and many-coloured toys, I called you ‘destiny’ and ‘encompassment of encompassments’ and ‘time’s umbilical cord’ and ‘azure bell’. O my soul, I gave your soil all wisdom to drink, all new wines and also all immemorially ancient strong wines of wisdom. O my soul, I poured every sun and every night and every silence and every longing upon you: – then you grew up for me like a vine. O my soul, now you stand superabundant and heavy, a vine

with swelling udders and close-crowded golden-brown wine-grapes: oppressed and weighed down by your happiness, expectant from abundance and yet bashful because of your expectancy. O my soul, now there is nowhere a soul more loving and encompassing and spacious! Where could future and past be closer together than with you? O my soul, I have given you everything and my hands have become empty through you: and now! now you ask me smiling and full of melancholy: ‘Which of us owes thanks? ‘does the giver not owe thanks to the receiver for receiving? Is giving not a necessity? Is taking not – compassion?’ O my soul, I understand the smile of your melancholy: your superabundance itself now stretches out longing hands! Your fullness looks out over raging seas and searches and waits; the longing of over-fullness gazes out of the smiling heaven of your eyes! And truly, O my soul I Who could behold your smile and not dissolve into tears? The angels themselves dissolve into tears through the over-kindness of your smile. It is your kindness and over-kindness that wishes not to complain and weep: and yet your smile longs for tears, O my soul, and your trembling mouth for sobs. ‘Is all weeping not a complaining? And all complaining not an accusing?’ Thus you speak to yourself, and because of that, O my soul, you will rather smile than pour forth your sorrow, pour forth in gushing tears all your sorrow at your fullness and at all the desire of the vine for the vintager and the vine-knife! But if you will not weep nor alleviate in weeping your purple melancholy, you will have to sing , O my soul! Behold, I smile myself, who foretold you this: to sing with an impetuous song, until all seas grow still to listen to your longing, until, over still, longing seas, the boat glides, the golden marvel around whose gold all good, bad, marvellous things leap: and many great and small beasts also, and everything that has light, marvellous feet that can run upon violet paths, towards the golden marvel, the boat of free will, and to its master: he, however, is the vintager who waits with diamond-studded vine-knife, your great redeemer, O my soul, the nameless one for whom only future songs will find a name! And truly, your breath is already fragrant with future songs, already you glow and dream, already you drink thirstily from all deep, resounding wells of comfort, already your melancholy reposes in the bliss of future songs! O my soul, now I have given you everything and even the last thing I had to give, and my hands have become empty through you: – that I bade you sing , behold, that was the last thing I had to give! That I bade you sing, now say, say: Which of us now – owes thanks? But better still: sing for me, sing, O my soul! And let me pay thanks! Thus spoke Zarathustra. The Second Dance Song 1 L ATELY I gazed into your eyes, O Life: I saw gold glittering in your eyes of night – my heart stood still with delight: I saw a golden bark glittering upon dark waters, a submerging, surging, re-emerging golden tossing bark! At my feet, my dancing-mad feet, you threw a glance, a laughing, questioning, melting tossing glance: Twice only did you raise your castanets in your little

hands – then my feet were already tossing in a mad dance. My heels raised themselves, my toes listened for what you should propose: for the dancer wears his ears – in his toes! I sprang to your side: then you fled back from my spring; towards me the tongues of your fleeing, flying hair came hissing! Away from you and from your serpents did I retire: then at once you stood, half turned, your eyes full of desire. With your crooked smile – you teach me crooked ways, upon crooked ways my feet learn – guile! I fear you when you are near, I love you when you are far; your fleeing allures me, your seeking secures me: I suffer, but for you what would I not gladly endure! For you whose coldness inflames, whose hatred seduces, whose flight constrains, whose mockery – induces: who would not hate you, great woman who binds us, en-winds us, seduces us, seeks us, finds us I Who would not love you, you innocent, impatient, wind-swift, child-eyed sinner! Where now do you take me, you unruly paragon? And again you forsake me, you sweet, ungrateful tomboy! I dance after you, I follow you even when only the slightest traces of you linger. Where are you? Give me your hand I Or just a finger! Here are caves and thickets: we shall go astray! Stop! Stand still! Do you not see owls and bats flitting away? Would you befool me? You bat! You owl! Where are we? Did you learn from the dogs thus to bark and howl? Your little white teeth you sweetly bare at me, from under your curly little mane your wicked eyes stare at me! This is a dance over dale and hill: I am the hunter – will you be my hound or will you be my kill? Now beside me! And quickly, you wicked rover I Now spring up! And across! – Help! In springing! myself have gone over! Oh see me lying, you wanton companion, and begging for grace! I long to follow you in – a sweeter chase! – love’s chase through flowery bushes, still and dim! Or there beside the lake, where goldfishes dance and swim! Are you now weary? There yonder are sheep and evening: let us end our pursuit: is it not sweet to sleep when the shepherd plays his flute? Are you so very weary? I will carry you there, just let your arms sink! And if you are thirsty – I should have something, but you would not like it to drink! – Oh this accursed, nimble, supple snake and slippery witch! Where have you gone? But on my face I feel from your hand two spots and blotches itch! I am truly weary of being your shepherd, always sheepish and meek! You witch, if I have hitherto sung for you, now for me you shall – shriek! To the rhythm of my whip you shall shriek and trot! Did I forget my whip? – I did not! 2 Then Life answered me thus, keeping her gentle ears closed: ‘O Zarathustra! Do not crack your whip so terribly! You surely know: noise kills thought – and now such tender thoughts are coming to me. ‘We are both proper ne’er-do-wells and ne’er-do-ills. Beyond good and evil did we discover our island and our green meadow – we two alone! Therefore we must love one another! ‘And even if we do not love one another from the very heart, do people have to dislike one another if they do not love one another from the very heart? ‘And that I love you and often love you too well, that I know: and

the reason is that I am jealous of your Wisdom. Ah, this crazy old fool, Wisdom! 'If your Wisdom should one day desert you, alas! then my love would quickly desert you too.' Thereupon, Life gazed thoughtfully behind her and around her and said gently: 'O Zarathustra, you are not faithful enough to me! 'You do not love me nearly as much as you say; I know you are thinking of leaving me soon. 'There is an old, heavy, heavy booming bell: it booms out at night up to your cave: 'when you hear this bell beat the hour at midnight, then you think between one and twelve – 'you think, O Zarathustra, I know it, you think of leaving me soon!' 'Yes,' I answered hesitatingly, 'but you also know....' And I said something into her ear, in the midst of her tangled, yellow, foolish locks. 'You know that, O Zarathustra? No one knows that.' And we gazed at one another and looked out at the green meadow, over which the cool evening was spreading, and wept together. But then Life was dearer to me than all my Wisdom had ever been. Thus spoke Zarathustra. 3 One! O Man! Attend! Two! What does deep midnight's voice contend? Three! 'I slept my sleep, Four! 'And now awake at dreaming's end: Five! 'The world is deep, Six! 'Deeper than day can comprehend. Seven! 'Deep is its woe, Eight! 'Joy – deeper than heart's agony: Nine! 'Woe says: Fade! Go! Ten! 'But all joy wants eternity, Eleven! ' – wants deep, deep, deep eternity!' Twelve! The Seven Seals (or: The Song of Yes and Amen) 1 I F I be a prophet and full of that prophetic spirit that wanders on high ridges between two seas, wanders between past and future like a heavy cloud, enemy to sultry lowlands and to all that is weary and can neither die nor live: ready for lightning in its dark bosom and for redeeming beams of light, pregnant with lightnings which affirm Yes! laugh Yes! ready for prophetic lightning-flashes: but blessed is he who is thus pregnant! And, in truth, he who wants to kindle the light of the future must hang long over the mountains like a heavy storm! Oh how should I not lust for eternity and for the wedding ring of rings – the Ring of Recurrence! Never yet did I find the woman by whom I wanted children, unless it be this woman, whom I love: for I love you, O Eternity! For I love you, O Eternity! 2 If ever my anger broke graves open, moved boundary-stones, and rolled old shattered law-tables into deep chasms: if ever my mockery blew away mouldered words, and if I came like a broom to the Cross-spiders and as a scouring wind to old sepulchres: if ever I sat rejoicing where old gods lay buried, world-blessing, world-loving, beside the monuments of old world-slanderers: for I love even churches and the graves of gods, if only heaven is looking, pure-eyed, through their shattered roofs; I like to sit like grass and red poppies on shattered churches: Oh how should I not lust for eternity and for the wedding ring of rings – the Ring of Recurrence! Never yet did I find the woman by whom I wanted children, unless it be this woman, whom I love: for I love VCM , O Eternity! For I love you, O Eternity! 3 If ever a breath of the creative breath has come to me, and a breath of that heavenly necessity that compels even

chance to dance in star-rounds: if ever I have laughed with the laugh of the creative lightning, which the thunder of the deed, grumbling but obedient, follows: if ever I have played dice with the gods at their table, the earth, so that the earth trembled and broke open and streams of fire snorted forth: for the earth is a table of the gods, and trembling with creative new words and the dice throws of the gods: Oh how should I not lust for eternity and for the wedding ring of rings – the Ring of Recurrence! Never yet did I find the woman by whom I wanted children, unless it be this woman, whom I love: for I love you, O Eternity! For I love you, O Eternity! 4 If ever I have drunk a full draught from that foaming mixing-bowl of spice, in which all things are well compounded: if ever my hand has welded the furthest to the nearest, and fire to spirit and joy to sorrow and the wickedest to the kindest: if I myself am a grain of that redeeming salt that makes everything mix well together in the bowl: for there is a salt that unites good with evil; and even the most evil is worthy to be a spice and a last over-foaming: Oh how should I not lust for eternity and for the wedding ring of rings – the Ring of Recurrence! Never yet did I find the woman by whom I wanted children, unless it be this woman, whom I love: for I love you, O Eternity! For I love you, O Eternity! 5 If I love the sea and all that is sea like, and love it most when it angrily contradicts me: if that delight in seeking that drives sails towards the undiscovered is in me, if a seafarer's delight is in my delight: if ever my rejoicing has cried: 'The shore has disappeared – now the last fetter falls from me, 'the boundless roars around me, far out glitter space and time, well then, come on! old heart!' Oh how should I not lust for eternity and for the wedding ring of rings – the Ring of Recurrence! Never yet did I find the woman by whom I wanted children, unless it be this woman, whom I love: for I love you, O Eternity! For I love you, O Eternity! 6 If my virtue is a dancer's virtue, and if I often leap with both feet in golden-emerald rapture: if my wickedness is a laughing wickedness, at home among rose bowers and hedges of lilies: for in laughter all evil is present, but sanctified and absolved through its own happiness: and if it be my Alpha and Omega that everything heavy shall become light, every body a dancer, all spirit a bird: and, truly, that is my Alpha and Omega! Oh how should I not lust for eternity and for the wedding ring of rings – the Ring of Recurrence! Never yet did I find the woman by whom I wanted children, unless it be this woman, whom I love: for I love you, O Eternity! For I love you, O Eternity! 7 If ever I spread out a still sky above myself and flew with my own wings into my own sky: if, playing, I have swum into deep light-distances and bird-wisdom came to my freedom: but thus speaks bird-wisdom: 'Behold, there is no above, no below! Fling yourself about, out, back, weightless bird I Sing! speak no more! 'are not all words made for the heavy? Do not all words lie to the light? Sing! speak no more!' Oh how should I not lust for eternity and for the wedding ring of rings – the Ring of Recurrence! Never yet

did I find the woman by whom I wanted children, unless it be this woman, whom I love: for I love you, O Eternity! For I love you, O Eternity! PART FOUR Alas, where in the world have there been greater follies than with the compassionate? And what in the world has caused more suffering than the follies of the compassionate? Woe to all lovers who cannot surmount pity Thus spoke the Devil to me once: Even God has his Hell: it is his love for man And I lately heard him say these words: God is dead; God has died of his pity for man

ZARATHUSTRA: ‘Of the Compassionate’ The Honey Offering AND again months and years passed over Zarathustra’s soul, and he did not heed it; his hair, however, grew white. One day, as he was sitting upon a stone before his cave and gazing silently out – but the outlook there is of the sea and tortuous abysses – his animals went thoughtfully around him and at last placed themselves in front of him. ‘O Zarathustra,’ they said, ‘are you perhaps looking out for your happiness?’ – ‘Of what account is happiness?’ he answered. ‘For long I have not aspired after happiness, I aspire after my work.’ ‘O Zarathustra,’ said the animals then, ‘you say that as one who has too many good things. Do you not lie in a sky-blue lake of happiness?’ ‘You buffoons,’ answered Zarathustra and smiled, ‘how well you chose that image! But you know too that my happiness is heavy and not like a liquid wave: it oppresses me and will not leave me, and behaves like molten pitch.’ Then his animals again went thoughtfully around him and placed themselves once more in front of him. ‘O Zarathustra,’ they said, ‘is that why you yourself are growing ever darker and more sallow, although your hair looks white and flaxen? Behold, you are sitting in your pitch!’ ‘What are you saying, my animals?’ said Zarathustra laughing. ‘Truly, I spoke slander when I spoke of pitch. What is happening to me happens to all fruits that grow ripe. It is the honey in my veins that makes my blood thicker, and my soul quieter.’ ‘It will be so, O Zarathustra,’ answered the animals and pressed towards him; ‘but would you not like to climb a high mountain today? The air is clear, and today one can see more of the world than ever.’ ‘Yes, my animals,’ he answered, ‘your advice is admirable and after my own inclination: today I will climb a high mountain! But take care that I have honey ready to hand there, yellow, white, fine, ice-cool golden honey in the comb. For I intend to offer the honey offering.’ But when Zarathustra had reached the summit he sent home the animals which had accompanied him, and found that he was now alone: then he laughed with his whole heart, looked around him and spoke thus: That I spoke of offerings and honey offerings was merely a ruse and, truly, a useful piece of folly! Up here I can speak more freely than before hermits’ caves and hermits’ pets. Offer – what? I squander what is given me, I, a squanderer with a thousand hands: how could I call that – an offering! And when I desired honey, I desired only bait and sweet syrup and gum, which even grumbling bears and strange, sullen, wicked birds are greedy for: the finest bait, such as huntsmen and fishermen need. For

although the world is like a dark animal-jungle and a pleasure-ground for all wild huntsmen, it seems to me to be rather and preferably an unfathomable, rich sea, a sea full of many-coloured fishes and crabs for which even the gods might long and become fishers and casters of nets: so rich is the world in strange things, great and small! Especially the human world, the human sea: now I cast my golden fishing-rod into it and say: Open up, human abyss! Open up and throw me your fishes and glistening crabs! With my finest bait shall I bait today the strangest human fish! My happiness itself shall I cast far and wide, between sunrise, noontide, and sunset, to see if many human fishes will not learn to kick and tug at my happiness, until they, biting on my sharp, hidden hooks, have to come up to my height, the most multicoloured groundlings of the abyss to the most wicked of all fishers of men. For I am he, from the heart and from the beginning, drawing, drawing towards me, drawing up to me, raising up, a drawer, trainer, and taskmaker who once bade himself, and not in vain: 'Become what you are!' Thus men may now come up to me: for I am still waiting for the signs that it is time for my descent; as yet I do not myself go down, as I must, among men. Therefore I wait here, cunning and scornful upon high mountains, not impatient, not patient, on the contrary one who has unlearned even patience, because he no longer 'suffers in patience'. 41 For my destiny is allowing me time: has it forgotten me? Or is it sitting in the shadows behind a great stone catching flies? And truly, I am grateful to my eternal destiny for not hunting and harrying me and for allowing me time for buffooneries and mischief: so that today I have climbed this high mountain to catch fish. Has a man ever caught fish on a high mountain? And if what I want and do up here is a stupidity, better to do it than to become solemn and green and sallow by waiting down there, to become by waiting a pompous shorter of wrath, a holy howling storm from the mountains, an impatient man crying down into the valleys: 'Listen, or I shall lash you with the scourge of God!' Not that I should be angry with such wrathful men on that account! They are good enough for a laugh! How impatient they must be, these great alarm-drums that must find a voice today or never! But I and my destiny – we do not speak to Today, neither do we speak to the Never: we have patience and time and more than time. For it must come one day and may not pass by. What must come one day and may not pass by? Our great Hazar, our great, far-off empire of man, the thousand-year empire of Zarathustra. How far off may that 'far off' be? What do I care! But I am not less certain of it on that account – I stand securely with both feet upon this foundation, upon this eternal foundation, upon hard, primordial rock, upon this highest, hardest primordial hill to which all the winds come as to the dividing-place of storms, asking Where? and Whence? and Whither? Here laugh, laugh my bright and wholesome wickedness! Down from high mountains cast your glistening, mocking laughter. With your glistening bait for me the fairest human fish! And what belongs to me

in all seas, my in-and-for-me in all things – fish it out for me, bring it here to me: I wait for it, I the wickedest of all fishermen. Away, away my hook! In, down, bait for my happiness! Drop down your sweetest dew, honey of my heart! Bite, my hook, into the belly of all black affliction! Gaze out, gaze out, my eye! Oh how many seas round about me, what dawning human futures! And above me – what rosy stillness! What cloudless silence! The Cry of Distress

THE following day Zarathustra was again sitting upon the stone before his cave while the animals were roving about in the world outside fetching fresh food – and fresh honey, too: for Zarathustra had consumed and squandered the old honey to the last drop. But as he was sitting there with a stick in his hand, tracing the shadow of his figure in the ground, thinking (and truly!) not about himself and his shadow – all at once he started back in alarm: for he saw another shadow beside his own. And as he quickly rose and looked around, behold, there stood beside him the prophet, the same that had once eaten and drunk at his table, the prophet of the great weariness who taught: ‘It is all one, nothing is worth while, the world is without meaning, knowledge chokes.’ But his face had changed in the interim; and when Zarathustra looked into the prophet’s eyes, his heart was again startled: so many evil prophecies and ashen lightning-flashes passed across this face! The prophet, who had perceived what was going on in Zarathustra’s soul, wiped his hand over his face, as if he wanted to wipe it away; Zarathustra did the same. And when each had silently composed and reassured himself, they shook hands as a sign that they wanted to recognize one another. ‘Welcome to you,’ said Zarathustra, ‘you prophet of the great weariness; not in vain shall you once have been guest at my table. Eat and drink with me today also, and forgive a cheerful old man for sitting down at table with you!’ ‘A cheerful old man?’ answered the prophet, shaking his head. ‘But whoever you are or want to be, O Zarathustra, you have little time left up here to be it – in a little time your boat shall no longer sit in the dry!’ ‘Am I then sitting in the dry?’ asked Zarathustra, laughing. ‘The waves around your mountain rise and rise,’ answered the prophet, ‘waves of great distress and affliction: soon they will lift your boat too, and carry you away.’ Thereupon Zarathustra was silent and wondered. ‘Do you still hear nothing?’ the prophet went on. ‘Does not the sound of rushing and roaring arise from the depths?’ Zarathustra was again silent and listened: then he heard a long, protracted cry, which the abysses threw from one to another, for none of them wanted to retain it, so evil did it sound. ‘You preacher of evil,’ said Zarathustra at last, ‘that is a cry of distress and a human cry, perhaps it comes from out a black sea. But what is human distress to me! The ultimate sin that is reserved for me – perhaps you know what it is called?’ ‘Pity!’ answered the prophet from an overflowing heart, and raised both hands aloft – ‘O Zarathustra, I come to seduce you to your ultimate sin!’ – And hardly were these words spoken than the cry rang out again, and more protracted and more distressful than before, and much

nearer. ‘Do you hear? Do you hear, O Zarathustra?’ cried the prophet. ‘The cry is meant for you, it calls to you: Come, come, come, it is time, it is high time!’ Hereupon Zarathustra was silent, confused, and deeply shaken; at last he asked like one undecided: ‘And who is it that calls me?’ ‘But you know who it is,’ answered the prophet vehemently, ‘why do you hide yourself? It is the Higher Man that cries for you!’ ‘The Higher Man?’ cried Zarathustra, horror-struck. ‘What does he want? What does he want? The Higher Man! What does he want here?’ – and his skin was covered with sweat. The prophet, however, did not respond to Zarathustra’s anguish, but listened intently towards the depths. But when it had remained quiet there for a long time, he turned his gaze back and saw Zarathustra standing and trembling. ‘O Zarathustra,’ he began in a scornful voice, ‘you do not stand there like one made giddy by happiness: you will have to dance if you are not to fall over! ‘But even if you were to dance before me and indulge in all your tricks, no one could say: “Behold, here dances the last happy man!” ‘Anyone who sought him here would visit these heights in vain: he would find caves, certainly, and backwood-caves, hiding-places for the hidden, but not mines of happiness and treasure-houses and new gold-veins of happiness. ‘Happiness – how could man find happiness with such buried men and hermits! Must I yet seek ultimate happiness upon blissful islands and far away among forgotten seas? ‘But it is all one, nothing is worth while, seeking is useless, and there are no blissful islands any more!’ Thus sighed the prophet; with his last sigh, however, Zarathustra again became cheerful and assured, like one emerging from a deep chasm into the light. ‘No! No! Thrice No!’ he cried vigorously, and stroked his beard. ‘I know better! There still are blissful islands! Do not talk about such things, you sighing sack-cloth! ‘Cease to splash about such things, you morning rain-cloud! Do I not stand here already wet with your affliction and drenched as a dog? ‘Now I shall shake myself and run away from you, so that I may become dry again: you must not be surprised at that! Do you think me discourteous? But this is my court. ‘But concerning your Higher Man: very well! I shall seek him at once in those forests: his cry came from there. Perhaps he is being attacked by an evil beast. ‘He is in my domain: here he shall not come to harm! And truly, there are many evil beasts about me.’ With these words Zarathustra turned to go. Then the prophet said: ‘O Zarathustra, you are a rogue! ‘I know it: you want to be rid of me! You would rather run into the forests and waylay evil beasts! ‘But what good will it do you? In the evening you will have me back; I shall sit in your own cave, patient and heavy as a log – and wait for you!’ ‘So be it!’ Zarathustra shouted behind him as he departed: ‘and whatever in my cave belongs to me also belongs to you, my guest! ‘But should you discover honey in there, very well! just lick it up, you growling bear, and sweeten your soul! For in the evening we must both be in good spirits, ‘in good spirits and glad that this day has ended! And you yourself shall dance to my songs as my dancing

bear. ‘You do not believe it? You are shaking your head? Very well! Go on, old bear! But I too – am a prophet!’ Thus spoke Zarathustra. Conversation with the Kings 1 Z ARATHUSTRA had not been going an hour through his mountains and forests when all at once he saw a strange procession. Along just that path that he was going down came two kings, adorned with crowns and purple sashes and bright as flamingos: they drove before them a laden ass. ‘What do these kings want in my kingdom?’ said Zarathustra in astonishment to his heart, and quickly concealed himself behind a bush. But as the kings drew abreast of him, he said, half aloud like someone talking to himself: ‘Strange! Strange! I cannot make this out! I see two kings – and only one ass!’ Then the two kings halted, smiled, gazed at the place from which the voice had come, and then looked one another in the face. ‘No doubt people think such things as that at home, too,’ said the king on the right, ‘but they do not utter them.’ The king on the left shrugged his shoulders and answered: ‘It is probably a goat-herd. Or a hermit who has lived too long among trees and rocks. For no company at all also corrupts good manners.’ ‘Good manners?’ replied the other king indignantly and bitterly. ‘What is it we are avoiding, then? Is it not “good manners”? Our “good company”? ‘Truly, better to live among hermits and goat-herds than with our gilded, false, painted rabble – although it calls itself “good company”, “although it calls itself “nobility”. But there everything is false and rotten, most of all the blood, thanks to old, evil diseases and worse quacks. ‘I think the finest and dearest man today is a healthy peasant, uncouth, cunning, obstinate, enduring; that is the noblest type today. ‘The peasant is the finest man today; and the peasantry should be master! But ours is the kingdom of the rabble – I no longer let myself be taken in. Rabble, however, means: hotchpotch. ‘Rabble-hotchpotch: in that everything is mixed up with everything else, saint and scoundrel and gentleman and Jew and every beast out of Noah’s Ark. ‘Good manners! Everything is false and rotten with us. Nobody knows how to be respectful any more: it is from precisely this that we are running away. They are honey-mouthed, importunate dogs, they gild palm-leaves. ‘It is this disgust that chokes me, that we kings ourselves have become false, arrayed and disguised in the old, yellowed pomp of our grandfathers, show-pieces for the stupidest and the craftiest and whoever today traffics with power! ‘We are not the first of them – yet we have to pretend to be: we have at last become tired and disgusted with this deception. ‘Now we are avoiding the mob, all these ranters and scribbling-blue bottles, the stench of shopkeepers, the struggles of ambition, the foul breath: faugh, to live among the mob, ‘faugh, to pretend to be the first among the mob! Ah, disgust! disgust! disgust! What do we kings matter any more!’ ‘Your old illness is assailing you,’ the king on the left said at this point, ‘disgust is assailing you, my poor brother. But you know that someone can overhear us.’ Hereupon Zarathustra, who had kept his ears and eyes open to these speeches, rose from his hiding-place, stepped

towards the kings and began: 'He who has overheard you, he who likes to overhear you, O kings, is called Zarathustra. 'I am Zarathustra, who once said: "What do kings matter any longer!" Forgive me, but I was glad when you said to one another: "What do we kings matter!" 'This, however, is my kingdom and dominion: what might you be seeking in my kingdom? But perhaps on your way you have found what I am seeking : that is, the Higher Man.' When the kings heard this they beat their breasts and said in a single voice: 'We have been recognized! 'With the sword of these words you have cut through the thickest darkness of our hearts. You have discovered our distress, for behold! we are on our way to find the Higher Man – 'the man who is higher than we: although we are kings. We are leading this ass to him. For the Highest Man shall also be the highest lord on earth. 'There is no harder misfortune in all human destiny than when the powerful of the earth are not also the first men. Then everything becomes false and awry and monstrous. 'And when they are even the last men and more beast than man, then the value of the rabble rises higher and higher and at last the rabble-virtue says: Behold, I alone am virtue!' 'What do I hear?' answered Zarathustra; 'what wisdom from kings! I am enchanted, and truly, I already feel the urge to compose a verse about it: 'even if it should be a verse not suited to everyone's ears. I long ago unlearned consideration for long ears. Very well! Come on! (But here it happened that the ass, too, found speech: it said clearly and maliciously 'Ye-a'.) 'Once on a time – 'twas A.D. One, I think – Thus spoke the Sybil, drunken without drink: "How bad things go! Decay! Decay! Ne'er sank the world so low! Rome is now a harlot and a brothel too, Rome's Caesar's a beast, and God himself – a Jew!"' 2 The kings were delighted with these lines of Zarathustra's; and the king on the right said: 'O Zarathustra, how well we did to come out and see you! 'For your enemies have shown us your image in their mirror, from which you gazed with the grimace of a devil and with mocking laughter, so that we were afraid of you. 'But what good was it! Again and again you stung our ears and hearts with your sayings. Then at last we said: What does it matter how he looks! 'We must hear him, him who teaches: You should love peace as a means to new wars and a short peace more than a long! 'No one ever spoke such warlike words: What is good? To be brave is good. It is the good war that hallows every cause. 'O Zarathustra, at such words the blood of our fathers stirred in our bodies: it was like spring speaking to old wine-casks. 'Our fathers loved life when swords were crossed like red-flecked serpents; they thought all suns of peace faint and feeble, but the long peace made them ashamed. 'How they sighed, our fathers, when they saw resplendent, parched swords upon the wall! Like them, they thirsted for war. For a sword wants to drink blood and sparkles with its desire.' As the kings thus eagerly talked and babbled of the happiness of their fathers, Zarathustra was overcome by no small desire to mock their eagerness: for they were apparently very

peaceable kings that he saw before him, with aged, refined faces. But he controlled himself. 'Very well!' he said, 'yonder leads the way to Zarathustra's cave; and this day shall have a long evening! But now a cry of distress calls me hurriedly away from you. 'My cave will be honoured if kings would sit and wait in it: but, to be sure, you will have to wait a long time! 'But really! What does it matter! Where today does one learn to wait better than in courts? And the whole virtue still remaining to kings – is it not today called: being able to wait!' Thus spoke Zarathustra. The Leech AND Zarathustra walked thoughtfully farther and deeper through forests and past swampy places; but, as happens with those who think on difficult things, on his way he unintentionally trod on a man. And behold, all at once a cry of pain and two curses and twenty little invectives spurted up into his face: so that in his fright he raised his stick and brought it down on the man he had trodden on. But he immediately came to his senses; and his heart laughed at the folly he had just committed. 'Forgive me,' he said to the man he had trodden on, who had angrily risen and sat down again, 'forgive me and first of all accept a parable. 'How a wanderer dreaming of distant things unintentionally stumbles over a dog on a lonely road, a dog lying in the sun: 'how they both start up and let fly at one another like mortal enemies, these two, frightened to death: thus it happened with us. 'And yet! And yet – how little was lacking for them to caress one another, this dog and this solitary! For they are both- solitaires!' 'Whoever you may be,' said the trodden-on man, still angry, 'you have come too near me with your parable and not only with your foot! 'For look, am I a dog?' – and thereupon the sitting man arose and drew his naked arm from the swamp. For previously he had lain stretched out on the ground, concealed and unrecognizable, like someone lying in wait for swamp game. 'But what are you doing!' cried Zarathustra in alarm, for he saw that a great deal of blood was running down the naked arm, 'what has happened to you? Has an evil beast bitten you, unhappy man?' The bleeding man laughed, still irritated. 'What is it to do with you!' he said, and made to go off. 'Here I am at home and in my domain. Whoever wants to question me, let him: but I shall hardly reply to a blockhead!' 'You are wrong,' said Zarathustra compassionately, and held him fast, 'you are wrong: here you are not in your own home but in my kingdom, and I will have no one come to harm here. 'But none the less, call me what you like – I am what I must be. I call myself Zarathustra. 'Very well! Up yonder leads the way to Zarathustra's cave: it is not far – will you not tend your wounds in my home? 'Things have gone ill with you in this life, you unhappy man: first a beast bit you, and then – a man trod on you!' But when the trodden-on man heard the name of Zarathustra, he changed. 'What has happened to me!' he cried; 'who concerns me in this life except this one man, Zarathustra, and that one beast that lives on blood, the leech? 'For the sake of the leech I have lain here beside this swamp like a fisherman, and already my outstretched arm has been bitten ten

times; now a fairer leech bites for my blood, Zarathustra himself! 'Oh happiness! Oh wonder! Praised be this day, that lured me to this swamp! Praised be the best, liveliest cupping-glass alive today, praised be the great leech of conscience, Zarathustra!' Thus spoke the man who had been trodden on; and Zarathustra rejoiced at his words and their fine, respectful manner. 'Who are you?' he asked, and offered him his hand, 'between us there is still much to elucidate and dear up: but already, it seems to me, it is bright, broad daylight.' 'I am the conscientious man of the spirit,' answered the other, 'and scarcely anyone is sterner, stricter, and more severe in things of the spirit than I, apart from him from whom I learned, Zarathustra himself. 'Better to know nothing than half-know many things! Better to be a fool on one's own account than a wise man at the approval of others! I – go to the root of things: 'what matter if it be great or small? If it be swamp or sky? A hand's breadth of ground is enough for me: if only it be thoroughly firm ground! 'a hand's breadth of ground: one can stand upon that. In truly conscientious knowledge there is nothing great and nothing small.' 'So perhaps you are an expert on the leech?' asked Zarathustra. 'And do you probe the leech down to its ultimate roots, conscientious man?' 'O Zarathustra,' answered the man who was trodden on, 'that would be a colossal task, how could I undertake it! 'But what I am master of and expert on is the leech's brain – that is my world! 'And that too is a world! But forgive me that my pride here speaks out, for here I have not my equal. That is why I said "Here I am at home". 'How long have I probed this one thing, the brain of the leech, so that slippery truth should here no longer slip away from me! Here is my kingdom! 'For its sake I have cast away all others, for its sake I have grown indifferent to all others; and close beside my knowledge couches my black ignorance. 'The conscience of my spirit demands of me that I know one thing and apart from that know nothing: I am disgusted by all the semi-intellectual, all the vaporous, hovering, visionary. 'Where my honesty ceases I am blind and want to be blind. But where I want to know I also want to be honest, that is, severe, stern, strict, cruel, inexorable. 'Because you, O Zarathustra, once said: "Spirit is the life that itself cuts into life", that led and seduced me to your teaching. And truly, with my own blood have I increased my own knowledge!' 'As the evidence indicates,' Zarathustra interposed; for blood continued to run down the naked arm of the man of conscience. For ten leeches had bitten into it. 'Oh you strange fellow, how much this evidence tells me, for it tells me about yourself! And perhaps I could not pour all of it into your stern ears! 'Very well! Let us part here! But I should like to meet you again. Up yonder leads the way to my cave: tonight you shall there be my welcome guest! 'And I should also like to make amends to your body for treading upon you: I shall think about that. But now a cry of distress calls me hurriedly away from you.' Thus spoke Zarathustra. The Sorcerer

1 W HEN Zarathustra had turned the corner around a rock, however, he saw not

far below him on the same pathway a man who was throwing his arms about as if in a frenzy and who finally hurled himself to earth flat on his belly. 'Stop!' said Zarathustra then to his heart, 'he yonder must surely be the Higher Man, that evil cry of distress came from him – I will see if he can be helped.' But when he ran to the spot where the man lay on the ground, he found a trembling old man with staring eyes; and however much Zarathustra tried to raise him and set him upon his legs, it was in vain. Neither did the unfortunate man seem to notice that there was anyone with him; on the contrary, he continually looked around him with pathetic gestures, like one forsaken by and isolated from all the world. Eventually, however, after much trembling, quivering, and self-contortion, he began to wail thus: Who still warms me, who still loves me? Offer me hot hands! Offer me coal-warmers for the heart! Spread-eagled, shuddering, Like a half-dead man whose feet are warmed – Shaken, alas! by unknown fevers, Trembling with sharp icy frost-arrows, Pursued by you, my thought! Unutterable, veiled, terrible one! Huntsman behind the clouds! Struck down by your lightning-bolt, You mocking eye that stares at me from the darkness – thus I lie, Bend myself, twist myself, tortured By every eternal torment, Smitten By you, cruel huntsman, You unknown – God! Strike deeper! Strike once again! Sting and sting, shatter this heart! What means this torment With blunt arrows? Why do you look down, Unwearied of human pain, With malicious divine flashing eyes? Will you not kill, Only torment, torment? Why – torment me, You malicious, unknown God? Ha ha! Are you stealing near? At such a midnight hour What do you want? Speak! You oppress me, press me – Ha! far too closely! Away! Away! You hear me breathing, You overhear my heart, You jealous God – Yet, jealous of what? Away! Away! Why the ladder? Would you climb Into my heart, Climb into my most secret Thoughts? Shameless, unknown – thief! What would you get by stealing? What would you get by listening? What would you get by torturing, You torturer? You – Hangman-god! Or shall I, like a dog, Roll before you? Surrendering, raving with rapture, Wag – love to you? In vain! Strike again, Cruellest knife! No, Not dog – I am only your game, Cruellest huntsman! Your proudest prisoner, You robber behind the clouds! For the last time, speak! What do you want, way layer, from me? You God veiled in lightning! Unknown One! Speak, What do you want, unknown – God? What? Ransom? How much ransom? Demand much – thus speaks my pride! And be brief – thus speaks my other pride! Ha ha! Me – you want me? Me – all of me?... Ha ha! And you torment me, fool that you are, You rack my pride? Offer me love – who still warms me? Who still loves me? – offer me hot hands! Offer me coal-warmers for the heart, Offer me, the most solitary, Whom ice, alas! sevenfold ice Has taught to long for enemies, For enemies themselves, Offer, yes yield to me, Cruellest enemy – Yourself! He is gone! He himself has fled, My last, sole companion, My great enemy, My unknown, My Hangman-god! No! Come back, With all your

torments! Oh come back To the last of all solitaires! All the streams of my tears
 Run their course to you! And the last flame of my heart – It burns up to you! Oh
 come back, My unknown God! My pain! My last – happiness! 2 At this point,
 however, Zarathustra could restrain himself no longer; he took his stick and
 struck the wailing man with all his force. ‘Stop!’ he shouted at him with furious
 laughter, ‘stop, you actor! You fabricator! You liar from the heart! I know you
 well! ‘I will warm your legs for you, you evil sorcerer, I well know how to make
 things warm for such as you!’ ‘Leave off,’ said the old man and jumped up from
 the ground, ‘beat me no more, O Zarathustra! I was doing it only in fun! ‘Such
 things are part of my art; I wanted to put you yourself to the proof when I gave
 you this exhibition! 42 And truly, you have seen well through me! ‘But you, too,
 have given me no small proof of yourself: you are hard , you wise Zarathustra!
 You strike hard with your “truths”, your cudgel forced from me – this truth!’ ‘Do
 not flatter,’ answered Zarathustra, still excited and frowning,’ you actor from the
 heart! You are false: why speak – of truth! ‘You peacock of peacocks, you ocean
 of vanity, what did you play before me, you evil sorcerer, in whom was I
 supposed to believe when you wailed in such a fashion?’ ‘ The penitent of the
 spirit ,’ said the old man, ‘it was he I played: you yourself once invented this
 expression – the poet and sorcerer who at last turns his spirit against himself, the
 transformed man who freezes through his bad knowledge and bad conscience.
 ‘And just confess it: it took a long time, O Zarathustra, for you to see through my
 trick and lie! You believed in my distress when you took my head in your hands,
 ‘I heard you wail: “He has been too little loved, too little loved!” My wickedness
 rejoiced within me that I had deceived you so far.’ ‘You may have deceived
 subtler men than me,’ said Zarathustra severely. ‘I am not on my guard against
 deceivers, I must be without caution: so my fate will have it. ‘You, however,
 must deceive: I know you so far. You must always be ambiguous, with two,
 three, four, five meanings! And what you just confessed was not nearly true
 enough and not nearly false enough for me! ‘You evil fabricator, how could you
 do otherwise! You would even deck your disease if you showed yourself naked
 to your physician. ‘Thus you decked your lie before me when you said “I was
 doing it only in fun!” There was also earnestness in it, you are something of a
 penitent of the spirit! ‘I have divined you well: you have become the enchanter
 of everyone, but against yourself you have no lie and no cunning left – you are
 disenchanted with yourself! ‘You have reaped disgust as your single truth. With
 you, no word is genuine any more, but your mouth is genuine: that is, the disgust
 that clings to your mouth.’ ‘But who are you!’ the old sorcerer cried at this point
 in a defiant voice, ‘who dares to speak like this to me , the greatest man, living
 today?’ – and a green lightning-flash shot from his eye at Zarathustra. But
 immediately he changed and said sadly: ‘O Zarathustra, I am tired of it, my arts
 disgust me, I am not great , why do I pretend! But, you know it well – I sought

greatness! 'I wanted to appear a great man and I convinced many: but this lie has been beyond my strength. I am collapsing under it. 'O Zarathustra, everything about me is a lie; but that I am collapsing – this is genuine !' 'It honours you,' said Zarathustra gloomily, casting down his eyes, 'it honours you that you sought greatness, but it also betrays you. You are not great. 'You evil old sorcerer, this is the best and most honest thing that I honour in you, that you have grown weary of yourself and have declared "I am not great". 'In that do I honour you as a penitent of the spirit: and, if only for a passing breath, in this one moment you were – genuine. 'But say, what do you seek here among my forests and cliffs? And when you laid yourself in my path, what proof did you want of me? 'What did you test me in?' Thus spoke Zarathustra and his eyes sparkled. The old sorcerer was silent for a time, then he said: 'Did I test you? I – only seek. 'O Zarathustra, I seek a genuine man, a proper, simple man, a man of one meaning and of all honesty, a repository of wisdom, a saint of knowledge, a great man! 'For do you not know, O Zarathustra? I seek Zarathustra .' And at this point a long silence arose between the two; Zarathustra, however, became deeply absorbed, so that he closed his eyes. Then, however, returning to his companion, he grasped the sorcerer's hand and said, with much politeness and guile: 'Very well! Up yonder leads the way to where Zarathustra's cave lies. You may seek there him you wish to find. 'And ask advice of my animals, my eagle and my serpent: they shall help you seek. But my cave is big. 'I myself, to be sure – I have never yet seen a great man. The eye of the subtlest is crude today for what is great. It is the kingdom of the mob. 'I have found so many who stretched and inflated themselves, and the people cried: "Behold a great man!" But what good are all bellows! The wind escapes from them at last. 'A frog that has blown itself out too long explodes at last: then the wind escapes. To prick the belly of a puffed-up windbag I call a fine sport. Hear that, lads! 'Today belongs to the mob: who still knows what is great, what small! Who could successfully seek greatness there! Only a fool: a fool would succeed. 'Do you seek great men, you strange fool? Who taught you to? Is today the time for it? Oh, you evil seeker, why – do you tempt 43 me?' Thus spoke Zarathustra, comforted at heart, and continued, laughing, on his way. Retired from Service N OT long after Zarathustra had freed himself from the sorcerer, however, he again saw someone sitting beside the path he was going: a tall, dark man with a pale, haggard face; this man greatly vexed him. 'Alas,' he said to his heart, 'there sits disguised affliction, he seems to be of the priestly sort: what do they want in my kingdom? 'What! I have hardly escaped from that sorcerer: must another magician cross my path, 'some wizard who operates by laying on hands, some gloomy miracle-worker by the grace of God, some anointed world-slanderer: may the Devil take him! 'But the Devil is never in his proper place: he always comes too late, that confounded dwarf and club-foot!' Thus cursed Zarathustra impatiently in his

heart and considered how, with averted gaze, he might slip past the dark man: but behold, it turned out differently. For at the same moment the sitting man had already seen him; and not unlike someone whom an unexpected happiness has befallen, he jumped up and went towards Zarathustra. 'Whoever you may be, traveller,' he said, 'help one who has gone astray, a seeker, an old man who may easily come to harm here! 'The world here is strange and remote to me, and I hear the howling of wild animals; and he who could have afforded me protection is himself no more. 'I was seeking the last pious man, a saint and hermit who, alone in his forest, had as yet heard nothing of what all the world knows today.' 'What does all the world know today?' asked Zarathustra. 'This, perhaps: that the old God in whom all the world once believed no longer lives?' 'That is so,' answered the old man sadly. 'And I served that old God until his last hour. 'Now, however, I am retired from service, without master, and yet I am not free, neither am I merry even for an hour, except in memories. 'That is why I climbed into these mountains, that I might at last celebrate a festival once more, as becomes an old pope and church-father: for know, I am the last pope! – a festival of pious memories and divine services. 'But now he himself is dead, the most pious of men, that saint in the forest who used continually to praise his God with singing and muttering. 'When I found his hut I no longer found him himself, but I did find two wolves in it, howling over his death – for all animals loved him. Then I hurried away. 'Had I come into these forests and mountains in vain? Then my heart decided to seek another, the most pious of all those who do not believe in God – to seek Zarathustra!' Thus spoke the old man and gazed with penetrating eyes at him who stood before him; Zarathustra, however, took the old pope's hand and for a long time regarded it admiringly. 'Behold, venerable man,' he said then, 'what a long and beautiful hand! It is the hand of one who has always distributed blessings. But now it holds fast him you seek, me, Zarathustra. 'It is I, the godless Zarathustra, the same who says: Who is more godless than I, that I may rejoice in his teaching?' Thus spoke Zarathustra and pierced with his glance the thoughts and reservations of the old pope. At last the latter began: 'He who loved and possessed him most, he has now lost him the most also: 'behold, am I myself not the more godless of us two now? But who could rejoice in that!' 'You served him to the last,' asked Zarathustra thoughtfully, after a profound silence, 'do you know how he died? Is it true what they say, that pity choked him, 'that he saw how man hung on the Cross and could not endure it, that love for man became his Hell and at last his death?' The old pope, however, did not answer, but looked away shyly and with a pained and gloomy expression. 'Let him go,' said Zarathustra after prolonged reflection, during which he continued to gaze straight in the old man's eye. 'Let him go, he is finished. And although it honours you that you speak only good of this dead god, yet you know as well as I who he was; and that he followed strange paths.' 'Between ourselves,' said the old pope,

becoming cheerful, 'or, as I may say, spoken beneath three eyes' 44 (for he was blind in one eye) 'in divine matters I am more enlightened than Zarathustra himself – and may well be so. 'My love served him long years, my will obeyed all his will. A good servant, however, knows everything, and many things, too, that his master hides from himself. 'He was a hidden god, full of secrecy. Truly, he even came by a son through no other than secret and indirect means. At the door of faith in him stands adultery. 'Whoever honours him as a god of love does not think highly enough of love itself. Did this god not also want to be judge? But the lover loves beyond reward and punishment. 'When he was young, this god from the orient, he was hard and revengeful and built himself a Hell for the delight of his favourites. 'But at length he grew old and soft and mellow and compassionate, more like a grandfather than a father, most like a tottery old grandmother. 'Then he sat, shrivelled, in his chimney corner, fretting over his weak legs, world-weary, weary of willing, and one day suffocated through his excessive pity.' 'Old pope,' Zarathustra interposed at this point, 'did you see that with your own eyes? It certainly could have happened like that: like that, and also otherwise. When gods die, they always die many kinds of death. 'But very well! One way or the other, one way and the other – he is gone! He offended the taste of my ears and eyes, I will say no worse of him. 'I love everything that is clear-eyed and honest of speech. But he – you must know it, old priest, there was something of your nature about him, something of the priestly nature – he was ambiguous. 'He was also indistinct. How angry he was with us, this shorter of wrath, because we mistook his meaning! But why did he not speak more clearly? 'And if our ears were to blame, why did he give us ears that were unable to hear him properly? If there was dirt in our ears, very well! who put it there? 'He had too many failures, this potter who had not learned his craft I But that he took vengeance on his pots and creations because they had turned out badly – that was a sin against good taste. 'There is also good taste in piety: that said at last: Away with such a god! Better no god, better to produce destiny on one's own account, better to be a fool, better to be God oneself!' 'What do I hear!' the old pope said at this point, pricking up his ears; 'O Zarathustra, you are more pious than you believe, with such an unbelief! Some god in you has converted you to your godlessness. 'Is it not your piety itself that no longer allows you to believe in a god? And your exceeding honesty will yet carry you off beyond good and evil, too! 'For behold, what has been reserved for you? You have eyes and hand and mouth destined for blessing from eternity. One does not bless with the hand alone. 'In your neighbourhood, although you would be the most godless, I scent a stealthy odour of holiness and well-being that comes from long benedictions: it fills me with joy and sorrow. 'Let me be your guest, O Zarathustra, for a single night! Nowhere on earth shall I be happier now than with you!' 'Amen! So shall it be!' said Zarathustra in great astonishment, 'up yonder leads the way, there lies

Zarathustra's cave. 'Indeed, I would gladly lead you there myself, venerable man, for I love all pious men. But now a cry of distress calls me hurriedly away from you. 'I will have no one come to harm in my domain; my cave is an excellent refuge. And most of all I should like to set every sad and sorrowful person again on firm land and firm legs. 'Who, however, could lift your melancholy from your shoulders? I am too weak for that. Truly, we should have to wait a long time before someone reawakened your god for you. 'For this old god no longer lives: he is quite dead.' Thus spoke Zarathustra. The Ugliest Man A ND again Zarathustra's feet ran through forests and mountains, and his eyes sought and sought, but him they desired to see, the great sufferer and crier of distress, was nowhere to be seen. All the time he was on his way, however, he rejoiced in his heart and was thankful. 'What good things this day has given me,' he said, 'as recompense for having begun so badly! What strange discourses I have found! 'Now I will long chew their words as if they were fine corn; my teeth shall grind and crunch them small, until they flow into my soul like milk!' But when the path again rounded a rock, all at once the scenery changed, and Zarathustra stepped into a kingdom of death. Here black and red cliffs projected up: no grass, no tree, no cry of birds. For it was a valley which all beasts avoided, even the beasts of prey; except that a kind of ugly, thick, green serpent, when it grew old, came here to die. Therefore the shepherds called this valley 'Serpent's Death'. Zarathustra, however, was plunged into dark recollections, for it seemed to him as if he had stood in this valley once before. And many heavy things settled upon his mind: so that he went slowly and ever slower and at last stopped. Then, however, as he opened his eyes, he saw something sitting on the pathway, shaped like a man and yet hardly like a man, something unutterable. And all at once Zarathustra was overcome by the great shame of having beheld such a thing: blushing to his white hair, he turned his glance away and lifted his foot to leave this evil spot. But then the dead wilderness resounded: for from the ground issued a gurgling, rasping sound such as water makes in stopped-up water-pipes at night; and at last a human voice and human speech emerged from it: it sounded thus: 'Zarathustra! Zarathustra! Read my riddle! Speak, speak! What is the revenge on the witness? 'I entice you back, here is slippery ice! Take care, take care that your pride does not here break its legs! 'You think yourself wise, proud Zarathustra! So read the riddle, you hard nut-cracker – the riddle that I am! So speak: who am I?' But when Zarathustra had heard these words, what do you think then happened to his soul? Pity overcame him ; and all at once he sank down, like an oak tree that has long withstood many woodchoppers, heavily, suddenly, to the terror even of those who wanted to fell it. But at once he arose from the ground and his countenance grew stern. 'I know you well,' he said in a brazen voice: 'you are the murderer of God ! Let me go. 'You could not endure him who saw you – who saw you unblinking and through and through, you

ugliest man! You took revenge upon this witness!’ Thus spoke Zarathustra and made to depart; but the unutterable creature grasped for a corner of his garment and began again to gurgle and grope for speech. ‘Stay!’ he said at last, ‘stay! Do not go by! I have divined what axe it was that struck you to earth: Hail to you, O Zarathustra, that you are standing again! ‘You have divined, I know it well, how he feels who killed God – how the murderer of God feels. Stay I Sit beside me; it is not to no purpose. ‘To whom did I intend to go if not to you? Stay, sit down! But do not look at me! Honour thus – my ugliness! ‘They persecute me: now you are my last refuge. Not with their hatred, not with their henchmen – oh, I would mock such persecution, I would be proud and glad of it! ‘Has not all success hitherto been with the well-persecuted? And he who persecutes well easily learns to follow 45 – for he is already – at the heels of others. But it is their pity, ‘it is their pity from which I flee and flee to you. O Zarathustra, my last refuge, protect me; you, the only one who can divine me: ‘you have divined how he feels who has killed him . Stay! And if you will go, impatient man, do not go the way I came. That way is bad. ‘Are you angry with me because I have mangled language too long? Because I have advised you? But know: it is I, the ugliest man, ‘who also have the biggest, heaviest feet. Where I have gone, the way is bad. I tread all roads to death and to destruction. ‘But that you went past me, silent; that you blushed, I saw it well: by that I knew you for Zarathustra. ‘Anyone else would have thrown me his alms, his pity, in glance and speech. But for that – I am not enough of a beggar, you have divined that – ‘for that I am too rich , rich in big things, in fearsome things, in the ugliest things, in the most unutterable things! Your shame, O Zarathustra, honoured me! ‘I escaped with difficulty from the importunate crowd of those who pity, that I might find the only one who today teaches “Pity is importunate” – you, O Zarathustra! ‘ – be it the pity of a god, be it human pity: pity is contrary to modesty. And unwillingness to help may be nobler than that virtue which comes running with help. ‘That however, pity, is called virtue itself with all little people – they lack reverence for great misfortune, great ugliness, great failure. ‘I look beyond all these, as a dog looks over the backs of swarming flocks of sheep. They are little, well-meaning, well-woolled, colourless people. ‘As a heron looks contemptuously over shallow ponds, with head thrown back: so do I look over the swarm of colourless little waves and wills and souls. ‘Too long have they been allowed right, these little people: thus at last they have been allowed power, too – now they teach: “Only that is good which little people call good.” ‘And “truth” today is what the preacher said who himself sprang from them, that strange saint and advocate of the little people who testified of himself “I – am the truth”. ‘This immodest man has long made the cock’s comb of the little people rise up in pride – he who taught no small error when he taught “I – am the truth”. ‘Was an immodest man ever answered more politely? But you, O Zarathustra,

passed him by and said: "No! No! Thrice No!" 'You warned against his error, as the first to do so, you warned against pity – no one else, only you and those of your kind. 'You are ashamed of the shame of the great sufferer; and truly, when you say "A great cloud emerges from pity, take care mankind!" 'When you teach "All creators are hard, all great love is beyond pity": O Zarathustra, how well-read in weather-omens you seem to me! 'You yourself, however – warn yourself too against your pity! For many are on their way to you, many suffering, doubting, despairing, drowning, freezing people – 'I warn you too against myself. You have read my best, my worst riddle, me myself, and what I have done. I know the axe that fells you. 'But he – had to die: he looked with eyes that saw everything – he saw the depths and abysses of man, all man's hidden disgrace and ugliness. 'His pity knew no shame: he crept into my dirtiest corners. This most curious, most over-important, over-compassionate god had to die. 'He always saw me : I desired to take revenge on such a witness – or cease to live myself. 'The god who saw everything, even man : this god had to die! Man could not endure that such a witness should live.' Thus spoke the ugliest man. Zarathustra, however, rose and prepared to go: for he was chilled to his very marrow. 'You unutterable creature,' he said, 'you warned me against your road. As thanks for that, I recommend you mine. Behold, up yonder lies Zarathustra's cave. 'My cave is big and deep and possesses many corners; there the best hidden man can find his hiding place. And close by it are a hundred secret and slippery ways for creeping, fluttering, and jumping beasts. 'You outcast who cast yourself out, do you not wish to live among men and the pity of men? Very well, do as I do. Thus you will also learn from me; only the doer learns. 'And first of all and above all speak with my animals! The proudest animal and the wisest animal – they may well be the proper counsellors for both of us!' Thus spoke Zarathustra and went his way, even more thoughtfully and slowly than before: for he asked himself many things and did not easily know what to answer. How poor is man! (he thought in his heart) how ugly, how croaking, how full of secret shame! They tell me that man loves himself: ah, how great must this self-love be! How much contempt is opposed to it! Even this man has loved himself as he has despised himself – he seems to me a great lover and a great despiser. I have yet found no one who has despised himself more deeply: even that is height. Alas, was he perhaps the Higher Man whose cry I heard? I love the great despisers. Man, however, is something that must be overcome. The Voluntary Beggar WHEN Zarathustra had left the ugliest man he felt chilled and alone: for he had absorbed much coldness and loneliness, to such an extent that even his limbs had grown colder. But he climbed on, up hill, down dale, past green pastures but also over wild, stony courses where no doubt an impatient brook had formerly made its bed: then all at once he grew warmer and more cheerful. 'What has happened to me?' he asked himself. 'Something warm and living refreshes me, it must be

nearby. 'Already I am less alone; unknown companions and brothers circle about me, their warm breath touches my soul.' But when he peered about him and sought the comforters of his loneliness, behold, they were cows standing together on a hillock; it was their nearness and odour that had warmed his heart. These cows, however, seemed to be listening eagerly to a speaker, and paid no heed to him who approached. And when Zarathustra was quite near them he clearly heard a human voice speaking from out the midst of the cows; and apparently they had all turned their heads towards the speaker. Then Zarathustra eagerly sprang up the hillock and pulled the animals away, for he feared that here someone had had an accident, which the sympathy of cows could hardly remedy. But in this he was deceived; for behold, there on the ground sat a man who appeared to be persuading the animals to have no fear of him, a peaceable man and mountain sermonizer out of whose eyes goodness itself preached. 'What do you seek here?' cried Zarathustra in surprise. 'What do I seek here?' he answered: 'the same as you seek, you peace-breaker! That is, happiness on earth. 'To that end, however, I may learn from these cows. For, let me tell you, I have already been talking to them half a morning and they were just about to reply to me. Why do you disturb them? 'If we do not alter and become as cows, we shall not enter into the kingdom of heaven. For there is one thing we should learn from them: rumination. 'And truly, if a man should gain the whole world and not learn this one thing, rumination: what would it profit him! He would not be free from his affliction, 'his great affliction: that, however, is today called disgust. Who today has not his heart, mouth, and eyes filled with disgust? You too! You too! But regard these cows!' Thus spoke the mountain sermonizer and then turned his glance upon Zarathustra, for up to then it had rested lovingly upon the cows: at that, however, he changed. 'Who is that I am speaking with?' he cried, startled, and jumped up from the ground. 'This is the man without disgust, this is Zarathustra himself, the overcomer of the great disgust, this is the eye, this is the mouth, this is the heart of Zarathustra himself.' And as he spoke thus he kissed the hands of him to whom he spoke with overflowing eyes, and behaved like someone to whom a valuable gift and jewel has unexpectedly fallen from heaven. The cows, however, looked on and were amazed. 'Do not speak of me, you strange, friendly man!' said Zarathustra, restraining his affection, 'first speak to me of yourself! Are you not the voluntary beggar who once threw away great riches, ' – who was ashamed of his riches and of the rich, and fled to the poor that he might give them his abundance and his heart? But they received him not.' 'But they received me not,' said the voluntary beggar, 'you know that. So at last I went to the animals and to these cows.' 'Then you learned', Zarathustra interrupted the speaker, 'how it is harder to give well than to take well, and that to give well is an art and the ultimate, subtlest master-art of kindness.' 'These days especially,' answered the voluntary beggar: 'for today everything base has

become rebellious and reserved and in its own way haughty: that is, in the mob's way. 'For the hour has come, you know it, for the great, evil, protracted, slow rebellion of the mob and the slaves: it grows and grows! 'Now all benevolence and petty giving provokes the base; and let the over-rich be on their guard! 'Whoever today lets drops fall like a big-bellied bottle out of a too-narrow neck – people like to break the necks of such bottles today. 'Lustful greed, bitter envy, sour vindictiveness, mob pride: all this threw itself in my face. It is no longer true that the poor are blessed. The kingdom of heaven, however, is with the cows.'

'And why is it not with the rich?' asked Zarathustra, tempting him, as he restrained the cows which were sniffing familiarly at the man of peace. 'Why do you tempt me?' answered the latter. 'You yourself know better even than I. For what drove me to the poorest, O Zarathustra? Was it not disgust with our richest? ' – disgust with those punished by riches, who glean advantage from all kinds of sweepings, with cold eyes, rank thoughts, disgust with this rabble that stinks to heaven, 'disgust with this gilded, debased mob whose fathers were pick-pockets or carrion-birds or ragmen with compliant, lustful, forgetful wives – for they are all of them not far from whores – 'mob above, mob below! What are "poor" and "rich" today! I unlearned this distinction – then I fled away, far away and ever farther, until I came to these cows.' Thus spoke the man of peace and himself snorted and perspired as he spoke: so that the cows were again amazed.

Zarathustra, however, looked him in the face with a smile all the while he was speaking so sternly, and then silently shook his head. 'You do violence to yourself, mountain sermonizer, when you use such stern words. Neither your mouth nor your eyes were made for such sternness. 'Nor your stomach either, as I think: that opposes all such raging and hating and over-frothing. Your stomach wants gentler things: you are no butcher. 'On the contrary, you seem to me a man of plants and roots. Perhaps you grind corn. But you are certainly disinclined to fleshy pleasures and love honey.' 'You have divined me well,' answered the voluntary beggar with lightened heart. 'I love honey, I also grind corn, for I have sought what tastes well and produces sweet breath: 'also what takes a long time, a day's work and a day's chewing for gentle idlers and sluggards. 'To be sure, these cows have attained the greatest proficiency in it: they have devised rumination and lying in the sun. And they abstain from all heavy thoughts that innate the heart.' 'Very well!' said Zarathustra: 'you shall see my animals, too, my eagle and my serpent – there is not their like on earth today. 'Behold, yonder leads the way to my cave: be its guest tonight. And speak with my animals of the happiness of animals, 'until I return home myself. For now a cry of distress calls me hurriedly away from you. You will find new honey, too, at my cave, golden honey in the comb, cold as ice: eat it! 'But now straightway take leave of your cows, you strange, friendly man! although it may be hard for you. For they are your warmest friends and teachers!' 'Except one, whom I love more,' answered

the voluntary beggar. 'You yourself are good, and even better than a cow, O Zarathustra!' 'Away, away with you! you arrant flatterer!' cried Zarathustra mischievously, 'why do you spoil me with such praise and honey of flattery?' 'Away, away from me!' he cried again and swung his stick at the affectionate beggar; he, however, ran nimbly away. The Shadow B UT hardly had the voluntary beggar run off and was Zarathustra alone again than he heard a new voice behind him calling: 'Stop! Zarathustra! Wait! It is I, O Zarathustra, I, your shadow!' But Zarathustra did not wait, for a sudden ill-humour overcame him on account of all the crowding and thronging on his mountains. 'Where has my solitude fled?' he said. 'Truly, it is becoming too much for me; these mountains are swarming, my kingdom is no longer of this world, I need new mountains. 'Does my shadow call me? Of what account is my shadow I Let it run after me! I – shall run away from it.' Thus spoke Zarathustra to his heart and ran off. But he who was behind him followed after: so that forthwith there were three runners one behind the other, that is, foremost the voluntary beggar, then Zarathustra, and thirdly and hindmost his shadow. They had not been running thus for long when Zarathustra became conscious of his folly and at once shook off his ill-humour and disgust. 'What!' he said, 'have not the most laughable things always happened with us old hermits and saints? 'Truly, my folly has grown high in the mountains! Now I hear six foolish old legs clattering one behind the other! 'But can Zarathustra really be afraid of a shadow? And anyway, I think it has longer legs than I.' Thus spoke Zarathustra, laughing with his eyes and his entrails, then stopped and turned quickly around – and behold, in doing so he almost threw his follower and shadow to the ground, the latter followed so closely upon his heels and was so weak. For when Zarathustra inspected him with his eyes, he was as terrified as if he had suddenly seen a ghost, so slight, dark, hollow, and spent did this follower appear. 'Who are you?' Zarathustra asked furiously, 'what are you doing here? And why do you call yourself my shadow? I do not like you.' 'Forgive me,' answered the shadow, 'that it is I; and if you do not like me, very good, O Zarathustra! I praise you and your good taste in that. 'I am a wanderer, who has already walked far at your heels: always going but without a goal and without a home: so that, truly, I am almost the eternal Wandering Jew, except that I am neither eternal nor a Jew. 'What? Must I always be going? Whirled by every wind, restless, driven onward? O Earth, you have grown too round for me! 'I have sat on every surface, like weary dust I have fallen asleep upon mirrors and window-panes: everything takes from me, nothing gives, I have become thin – I am almost like a shadow. 'But I have fled to you and followed you longest, O Zarathustra, and although I have hidden myself from you, yet I was your best shadow: where you have sat there I sat too. 'I have travelled with you in the remotest, coldest worlds, like a ghost that voluntarily walks over snow and winter roofs. 'I have striven with you into all that was forbidden, worst, most

remote: and if anything in me be a virtue, it is that I have feared no prohibition. 'I have broken up with you whatever my heart revered. I have overthrown boundary stones and statues, I have pursued the most dangerous desires – truly, I once went beyond every crime. 'I have unlearned with you belief in words and values and great names. When the Devil casts his skin does his name not also fall away? For that too is a skin. The Devil himself is perhaps – a skin. "Nothing is true, everything is permitted": thus I told myself. I plunged into the coldest water, with head and heart. Alas, how often I stood naked, like a red crab, on that account! 'Alas, where have all my goodness and shame and belief in the good fled! Alas, where is that mendacious innocence that I once possessed, the innocence of the good and their noble lies! 'Truly, too often did I follow close by the feet of truth: then it kicked me in the face. Sometimes I intended to lie, and behold! only then did I hit – the truth. 'Too much has become clear to me: now I am no longer concerned with it. No longer is there anything living that I love – how should I still love myself? "To live as I desire to live or not to live at all": that is what I want, that is what the most saintly man wants. But alas! how can I still have – a desire? 'Have I – still a goal? A haven to which my sail races? 'A good wind? Alas, only he who knows where he is going knows which wind is a good and fair wind for him. 'What is left to me? A heart weary and insolent; a restless will; infirm wings; a broken backbone. 'This seeking for my home: O Zarathustra, do you know this seeking was my affliction, 46 it is consuming me. 'Where is – my home? I ask and seek and have sought for it, I have not found it. Oh eternal Everywhere, oh eternal Nowhere, oh eternal – Vanity!' Thus spoke the shadow, and Zarathustra's face lengthened at his words. 'You are my shadow!' he said at length, sorrowfully. 'Your danger is no small one, you free spirit and wanderer! You have had a bad day: see you do not have a worse evening! 'Even a prison at last seems bliss to such restless people as you. Have you ever seen how captured criminals sleep? They sleep peacefully, they enjoy their new security. 'Take care that you are not at last captured by a narrow belief, a hard, stern illusion! For henceforth everything that is narrow and firm will entice and tempt you. 'You have lost your goal: alas, how will you get over and laugh away that loss? By losing your goal – you have lost your way, too! 'You poor traveller, wanderer, you weary butterfly! Would you this evening have a resting place and homestead? So go up to my cave! 'Yonder leads the way to my cave. And now I will run quickly away from you again. Already it is as if a shadow were lying upon me. 'I will run alone, so that it may again grow bright around me. For that I still have to be a long time merrily on my legs. In the evening, however, we shall – dance!' Thus spoke Zarathustra. At Noontide A ND Zarathustra ran and ran and found no one else and was alone and found himself again and again and enjoyed and relished his solitude and thought of good things, for hours on end. About the hour of noon, however, when the sun stood exactly over Zarathustra's head, he

passed by an old gnarled and crooked tree which was embraced around by the abundant love of a vine and hidden from itself: from the vine an abundance of yellow grapes hung down to the wanderer. Then he felt a desire to relieve a little thirst and to pluck himself a grape; but when he had already extended his arm to do so, he felt an even greater desire to do something else: that is, to lie down beside the tree at the hour of perfect noon and sleep. This Zarathustra did; and no sooner had he lain down upon the ground, in the stillness and secrecy of the multicoloured grass, than he forgot his little thirst and fell asleep. For, as Zarathustra's saying has it: One thing is more necessary than another. Only his eyes remained open – for they were not wearied of seeing and admiring the tree and the love of the vine. In falling asleep, however, Zarathustra spoke thus to his heart: Soft! Soft! Has the world not just become perfect? What has happened to me? As a delicate breeze, unseen, dances upon the smooth sea, light, light as a feather: thus – does sleep dance upon me. My eyes it does not close, my soul it leaves awake. It is light, truly I light as a feather. It persuades me, I know not how; it inwardly touches me with a caressing hand, it compels me. Yes, it compels me, so that my soul stretches itself out: how lengthy and weary my soul has grown, my strange soul! Has a seventh day's evening come to it just at noontide? Has it wandered too long, blissfully, among good and ripe things? It stretches itself out, long, long – longer! it lies still, my strange soul. It has tasted too many good things, this golden sadness oppresses it, it makes a wry mouth. Like a ship that has entered its stillest bay – now it leans against the earth, weary of long voyages and uncertain seas. Is the earth not more faithful? As such a ship lies against the shore, nestles against the shore – there it suffices for a spider to spin its thread out to it from the land. No stronger ropes are needed. As such a weary ship rests in the stillest bay: thus do I now rest close to the earth, faithful, trusting, waiting, fastened to it by the finest threads. Oh happiness! Oh happiness! Would you sing, O my soul? You lie in the grass. But this is the secret, solemn hour when no shepherd plays his flute. Take care! Hot noontide sleeps upon the fields. Do not sing! Soft! The world is perfect. Do not sing, you grass bird, O my soul! Do not even whisper! Just see – soft! old noontide sleeps, it moves its mouth: has it not just drunk a drop of happiness – an ancient brown drop of golden happiness, of golden wine? Something glides across it, its happiness laughs. Thus – does a god laugh. Soft! 'Happiness; how little attains happiness!' Thus I spoke once and thought myself wise. But it was a blasphemy: I have learned that now. Wise fools speak better. Precisely the least thing, the gentlest, lightest, the rustling of a lizard, a breath, a moment, a twinkling of the eye – little makes up the quality of the best happiness. Soft! What has happened to me? Listen! Has time flown away? Do I not fall? Have I not fallen – listen! into the well of eternity? What is happening to me? Still! Is it stinging me – alas – in the heart? In the heart! oh break, break, heart, after such happiness, after

such stinging! What? Has the world not just become perfect? Round and ripe? Oh, golden round ring 47 – whither does it fly? Away, after it! Away! Soft – (and at this point Zarathustra stretched himself and felt that he was asleep). Up! (he said to himself) up, sleeper! You noontide sleeper! Very well, come on, old legs I! It is time and past time, you have still a good way to go. You have slept your fill, how long? Half an eternity! Very well, come on, my old heart! For how long after such a sleep may you – wake your fill? (But then he fell asleep again, and his soul contradicted him and resisted and again lay down.) ‘Let me alone! Soft! Has the world not just become perfect? Oh perfect as a round golden ball!’ Get up (said Zarathustra), you little thief, you lazybones! 48 What! Still stretching, yawning, sighing, falling into deep wells? But who are you then, O my soul? (And at this point he started, for a ray of sunlight had glanced down from the sky on to his face.) O sky above me (he said, sighing, and sat upright), are you watching me? Are you listening to my strange soul? When will you drink this drop of dew that has fallen upon all earthly things – when will you drink this strange soul – when, well of eternity! serene and terrible noontide abyss! when will you drink my soul back into yourself? Thus spoke Zarathustra and raised himself from his bed beside the tree as from a strange intoxication: and behold, the sun was still standing straight above his head. One might rightly gather from that, however, that Zarathustra had not been sleeping for long. The Greeting I T was only in the late afternoon that Zarathustra, after long, vain searching and roaming about, returned home to his cave. But when he was opposite it, not twenty paces away, then occurred that which he now least expected: he heard again the great cry of distress. And astonishing thing! this time it came from his own cave. It was a protracted, manifold, strange cry, however, and Zarathustra clearly distinguished that it was composed of many voices: although, heard from a distance, it might sound like a cry from a single throat. Thereupon, Zarathustra sprang towards his cave, and behold! what a spectacle awaited him after that concert! For all those whom he had passed by that day were seated together: the king on the right and the king on the left, the old sorcerer, the pope, the voluntary beggar, the shadow, the conscientious man of the spirit, the sorrowful prophet, and the ass; the ugliest man, however, had placed a crown upon his head and slung two purple sashes around him, for, like all the ugly, he loved to disguise and embellish himself. But in the midst of this melancholy company stood Zarathustra’s eagle, agitated and with feathers ruffled, for he had been expected to answer too much for which his pride had no answer; the wise serpent, however, hung about its neck. Zarathustra beheld all this with great amazement; then, however, he examined each of his guests with gentle curiosity, read what was in their souls, and was amazed anew. In the meantime the assembled guests had risen from their seats and were respectfully waiting for Zarathustra to speak. Zarathustra, however, spoke thus: You despairing men! You strange men! So was

it your cry of distress I heard? And now I know, too, where to seek him whom I sought today in vain: the Higher Man – he sits in my own cave, the Higher Man! But why am I surprised! Have I myself not enticed him to me with honey offerings and cunning bird-calls of my happiness? But it seems to me you are ill adapted for company, you disturb one another's hearts, you criers of distress, when you sit here together? First of all someone else must come, someone to make you laugh again, a good, cheerful Jack Pudding, a dancer and breeze and madcap, some old fool or other: – what do you think? But forgive me, you despairing men, that I speak before you such petty words, truly unworthy of such guests I But you do not guess what makes my heart wanton: you yourselves do it, and the sight of you, forgive me for it! For anyone beholding a man in despair grows brave. To encourage a despairing man – anyone thinks himself strong enough for that. To me have you given this strength – a goodly guest-gift, my exalted guests! Very well, do not be angry with me if I offer you something of mine. This is my kingdom and my domain: but what is mine shall be yours for this evening and this night. My animals shall serve you: let my cave be your resting place! No one shall despair at my hearth and home, I protect everyone from his wild animals in my preserve. And that is the first thing I offer you: security! The second, however, is: my little finger. And when you have that, take the whole hand, very well! and the heart in addition! Welcome to this place, welcome, my guests! Thus spoke Zarathustra and laughed with love and mischievousness. After this greeting, his guests bowed themselves again and held a respectful silence; the king on the right, however, replied to him in their name. By the manner in which you have offered us hand and greeting, O Zarathustra, do we recognize you as Zarathustra. You have humbled yourself before us; you have almost injured our respect: but who could have humbled himself with such pride as you? That uplifts us ourselves, it is a refreshment to our eyes and hearts. Just to see this would we climb higher mountains than this mountain. For we have come as sightseers, we wanted to see what makes sad eyes bright. And behold, already all our distressful crying is over. Already our hearts and minds are opened and delighted. Little is needed for our hearts to grow wanton. Nothing more gladdening grows on earth, O Zarathustra, than an exalted, robust will: it is the earth's fairest growth. A whole landscape is refreshed by one such tree. To the pine-tree, O Zarathustra, do I compare him who grows up like you: tall, silent, hard, alone, of the finest, supplest wood, magnificent – at last, however, reaching out with strong, green branches for its domain, asking bold questions of the winds and storms and whatever is at home in the heights, replying more boldly, a commander, a victor: oh who would not climb high mountains to behold such trees? The gloomy man, too, and the ill-constituted, refresh themselves at your tree, O Zarathustra; at your glance even the restless man grows secure and heals his heart. And truly, many eyes today are raised to your mountain and your tree; a

great longing has arisen, and many have learned to ask: Who is Zarathustra? And he into whose ear you have ever poured your song and your honey: all the hidden men, the hermits and hermit-couples, say all at once to their hearts: 'Does Zarathustra still live? There is no longer any point in living, it is all one, everything is in vain: except we live with Zarathustra!' 'Why does he not come, he who has proclaimed himself so long?' thus many ask. 'Has solitude devoured him? Or should we perhaps go to him?' Now solitude itself yields and breaks apart and can no longer contain its dead. The resurrected are to be seen everywhere. Now the waves rise and rise around your mountain, O Zarathustra. And however high your height may be, many must reach up to you: your boat shall not sit in the dry for much longer. And that we despairing men have now come into your cave and are already no longer despairing: that is only a sign and omen that better men are on their way to you; for this itself is on its way to you, the last remnant of God among men, that is: all men possessed by great longing, great disgust, great satiety, all who do not want to live except they learn to hope again – except they learn from you, O Zarathustra, the great hope! Thus spoke the king on the right and grasped Zarathustra's hand to kiss it; but Zarathustra resisted his adoration and stepped back startled, silently and abruptly, as if escaping into the far distance. But after a short while he was again with his guests, regarded them with clear, questioning eyes, and said: My guests, you Higher Men, I will speak clearly and in plain German to you. 49 It is not for you that I have been waiting in these mountains. ('Clearly and in plain German? God help us!' said the king on the left to himself at this point; 'it is clear he does not know the good Germans, this wise man from the East! 'But he means "uncouthly and in German" – very well! Nowadays that is not in quite the worst taste!') Truly, you may all be Higher Men (Zarathustra went on): but for me – you are not high and strong enough. For me, that is to say: for the inexorable that is silent within me but will not always be silent. And if you belong to me, it is not as my right arm. For he who himself stands on sick and tender legs, as you do, wants above all, whether he knows it or conceals it from himself: to be spared. My arms and my legs, however, I do not spare, I do not spare my warriors: how, then, could you be fit for my warfare? With you I should still spoil every victory. And some of you would give in simply on hearing the loud beating of my drums. Neither are you handsome enough nor sufficiently wellborn for me. I need pure, smooth mirrors for my teaching; upon your surface even my own reflection is distorted. Many a burden, many a memory weighs down your shoulders; many an evil dwarf crouches in your corners. And there is hidden mob in you, too. And although you are high and of a higher type, much in you is crooked and malformed. There is no smith in the world who could hammer you straight and into shape for me. You are only bridges: may higher men than you step across upon you! You are steps: so do not be angry with him who climbs over you into

bis height! From your seed there may one day grow for me a genuine son and perfect heir: but that is far ahead. You yourselves are not those to whom my heritage and name belong. It is not for you that I wait here in these mountains, it is not with you that I may go down for the last time. You have come to me only as omens that higher men are already on their way to me, not men possessed of great longing, great disgust, great satiety, and that which you called the remnant of God, No! No! Thrice No! It is for others that I wait here in these mountains and I will not lift my foot from here without them, for higher, stronger, more victorious, more joyful men, such as are square-built in body and soul: laughing lions must come! O my guests, you strange men, have you yet heard nothing of my children? And that they are on their way to me? Speak to me of my gardens, of my Blissful Islands, of my beautiful new race, why do you not speak of them? This guest-gift do I beg of your love, that you speak to me of my children. In them I am rich, for them I became poor: what have I not given, what would I not give, to possess one thing: these children, this living garden, these trees of life of my will and of my highest hope! Thus spoke Zarathustra and suddenly halted in his discourse: for his longing overcame him and he closed his eyes and mouth because his heart was so moved. And all his guests, too, remained silent and stood still and dismayed: except that the old prophet started to make signs with his hands and his features. The Last Supper F OR at this point the prophet interrupted the greeting of Zarathustra and his guests: he thrust himself forward like one with no time to lose, grasped Zarathustra's hand and cried: 'But Zarathustra! 'One thing is more necessary than another, so you say yourself: very well, one thing is now more necessary to me than all others. 'A word in season: did you not invite me to a meal? And here are many who have travelled far. You don't intend to fob us off with speeches, do you? 'Besides, you have all been thinking too much about freezing, drowning, choking, and other physical dangers: no one, however, has thought about my danger, that is, starving – ' (Thus spoke the prophet; but when Zarathustra's animals heard his words they ran off in terror. For they saw that all they had brought home during the day would not suffice to cram this one philosopher.) 'And dying of thirst,' the prophet went on. 'And although I have heard water splashing here like speeches of wisdom, plenteous and unceasing: I – want wine! 'Not everyone is a born water-drinker, like Zarathustra. Neither is water of any use to weary and drooping men: we ought to have wine – that alone brings sudden recovery and unpremeditated health!' On this occasion, when the prophet desired wine, it happened that the king on the left, the silent one, also found speech for once. 'We have provided for wine,' he said, 'I and my brother, the king on the right: we have wine enough – a whole ass's load of it. So nothing is lacking but bread.' 'Bread?' replied Zarathustra laughing. 'It is precisely bread that hermits do not have. But man does not live by bread alone, but also by the flesh of good lambs,

of which I have two. 'Let us quickly slaughter these and prepare them spicily with sage: that is how I like it. And neither is there any lack of roots and fruits, fine enough even for gourmets and epicures; nor of nuts and other riddles that need cracking. 'Thus we shall very shortly partake of an excellent meal. But whoever wants to eat with us must also lend a hand, even the kings. For with Zarathustra even a king may be a cook.' Everyone heartily agreed with this suggestion: except that the voluntary beggar exclaimed against flesh and wine and spices. 'Just listen to this glutton Zarathustra!' he said jokingly: 'does one take to caves and high mountains in order to partake of such meals? 'To be sure, I now understand what he once taught us: "Praised be a moderate poverty!" and why he wants to abolish beggars.' 'Be of good cheer,' Zarathustra replied to him, 'as I am. Stick to your usual custom, admirable man: grind your corn, drink your water, praise your own cooking: if only it makes you happy! 'I am a law only for my own, I am not a law for all. But he who belongs to me must be strong-limbed and nimble-footed, 'merry in war and feasting, no mournful man, no dreamy fellow, ready for what is hardest as for a feast, healthy and whole. 'The best belongs to me and mine; and if we are not given it, we take it: the best food, the purest sky, the most robust thoughts, the fairest women!' Thus spoke Zarathustra; the king on the right, however, replied: 'Strange! Did one ever hear such clever things from the mouth of a philosopher? 'And truly, it is the rarest thing to find a philosopher clever as well as wise, and not an ass.' Thus spoke the king on the right and wondered; the ass, however, maliciously replied to his speech with 'Ye-a.' This, however, was the beginning of that long meal which is called 'The Last Supper' 50 in the history books. And during that meal nothing was spoken of but the Higher Man. Of the Higher Man 1 W HEN I went to men for the first time, I committed the folly of hermits, the great folly: I set myself in the market-place. And when I spoke to everyone, I spoke to no one. In the evening, however, tight-rope walkers and corpses were my companions; and I myself was almost a corpse. With the new morning, however, came to me a new truth: then I learned to say: 'What are the market-place and the mob and the mob's confusion and the mob's long ears to me!' You Higher Men, learn this from me: In the market-place no one believes in Higher Men. And if you want to speak there, very well, do so! But the mob blink and say: 'We are all equal.' 'You Higher Men' – thus the mob blink – 'there are no Higher Men, we are all equal, man is but man, before God – we are all equal!' Before God! But now this God has died. And let us not be equal before the mob. You Higher Men, depart from the market-place! 2 Before God! But now this God has died! You Higher Men, this God was your greatest danger. Only since he has lain in the grave have you again been resurrected. Only now does the great noontide come, only now does the Higher Man become – lord and master! Have you understood this saying, O my brothers? Are you terrified: do your hearts fail? Does the abyss here yawn for you? Does the hound of Hell

here yelp at you? Very well! Come on, you Higher Men! Only now does the mountain of mankind's future labour. God has died: now we desire – that the Superman shall live. 3 The most cautious people ask today: 'How may man still be preserved?' Zarathustra, however, asks as the sole and first one to do so: 'How shall man be overcome?' The Superman lies close to my heart, he is my paramount and sole concern – and not man: not the nearest, not the poorest, not the most suffering, not the best. O my brothers, what I can love in man is that he is a going-across and a going-down. And in you, too, there is much that makes me love and hope. That you have despised, you Higher Men, that makes me hope. For the great despisers are the great reverers. That you have despaired, there is much to honour in that. For you have not learned how to submit, you have not learned petty prudence. For today the petty people have become lord and master: they all preach submission and acquiescence and prudence and diligence and consideration and the long et cetera of petty virtues. What is womanish, what stems from slavishness and especially from the mob hotchpotch: that now wants to become master of mankind's entire destiny – oh disgust! disgust! That questions and questions and never tires: 'How may man preserve himself best, longest, most agreeably?' With that – they are the masters of the present. Overcome for me these masters of the present, O my brothers – these petty people: they are the Superman's greatest danger! Overcome, you Higher Men, the petty virtues, the petty prudences, the sand-grain discretion, the ant-swarm inanity, miserable ease, the 'happiness of the greatest number'! And rather despair than submit. And truly, I love you because you do not know how to live today, you Higher Men! For thus do you – live best! 4 Do you possess courage, O my brothers? Are you stouthearted? Not courage in the presence of witnesses, but hermits' and eagles' courage, which not even a god observes any more? I do not call cold-spirited, mulish, blind, or intoxicated men stout-hearted. He possesses heart who knows fear but masters fear; who sees the abyss, but sees it with pride. He who sees the abyss, but with an eagle's eyes – he who grasps the abyss with an eagle's claws: he possesses courage. 5 'Man is evil' – all the wisest men have told me that to comfort me. Ah, if only it be true today! For evil is man's best strength. 'Man must grow better and more evil' – thus do I teach. The most evil is necessary for the Superman's best. It may have been good for that preacher of the petty people to bear and suffer the sin of man. I, however, rejoice in great sin as my great consolation. But these things are not said for long ears. Neither does every word belong in every mouth. They are subtle, remote things: sheep's hooves ought not to grasp for them! 6 You Higher Men, do you think I am here to put right what you have done badly? Or that I mean henceforth to make more comfortable beds for you sufferers? Or show you restless, erring, straying men new, easier footpaths? No! No! Thrice No! More and more, better and better men of your kind must perish – for life must be harder and harder for

you. Only thus, only thus does man grow to the height where the lightning can strike and shatter him: high enough for the lightning! My mind and longing go out to the few, the protracted, the remote things: what are your many, little, brief miseries to me! You have not yet suffered enough! For you suffer from yourselves, you have not yet suffered from man. You would lie if you said otherwise! None of you suffer from what I have suffered. 7 It does not suffice me that the lightning no longer does harm. I do not want to conduct it away: it shall learn – to work for me. My wisdom has long collected itself like a cloud, it is growing stiller and darker. Thus does every wisdom that shall one day give birth to lightnings. I do not want to be light for these men of the present, or be called light by them. These men – I want to blind: lightning of my wisdom! put out their eyes! 8 Do not will beyond your powers: there is an evil falsity about those who will beyond their powers. Especially when they will great things! For they awaken mistrust of great things, these subtle fabricators and actors: until at last they are false to themselves, squint-eyed, whitewashed rottenness, cloaked with clever words, with pretended virtues, with glittering, false deeds. Guard yourselves well against that, you Higher Men! For I count nothing more valuable and rare today than honesty. Does this present not belong to the mob? The mob, however, does not know what is great or small, what is straight and honest: it is innocently crooked, it always lies. 9 Have a healthy mistrust today, you Higher Men, you stouthearted, open-hearted men! And keep your reasons secret! For this present belongs to the mob. Who could overturn with reasons what the mob has once learned to believe without reasons? And in the market-place one convinces with gestures. But reasons make the mob mistrustful. And when truth has triumphed for once, then you have asked with healthy mistrust: ‘What mighty error has fought fork?’ Be on your guard, too, against the learned! They hate you: for they are unfruitful! They have cold, dried-up eyes, before which all birds lie stripped of their feathers. They boast that they do not tell lies: but inability to lie is far from being love of truth. Be on your guard I Freedom from fever is far from being knowledge! I do not believe frozen spirits. He who cannot lie does not know what truth is. 10 If you want to rise high, use your own legs! Do not let yourselves be carried up, do not sit on the backs and heads of strangers! But did you mount horse? Do you now ride pell-mell up to your goal? Very well, my friend! But your lame foot also sits with you on your horse! When you reach your goal, when you jump from your horse: precisely upon your height you Higher Man, will you stumble! 11 You creators, you Higher Men! One is pregnant only with one’s own child. Let nothing impose upon you, nothing persuade you! For who is your neighbour? And if you do things ‘for your neighbour’, still you do not create for him! Unlearn this ‘for’, you creators: your very virtue wants you to have nothing to do with ‘for’ and ‘for the sake of and ‘because’. You should stop your ears to these false little words. This ‘for one’s

neighbour' is the virtue only of petty people: there they say 'birds of a feather' and 'one good turn deserves another' – they have neither right to nor strength for your selfishness! The prudence and providence of pregnancy is in your selfishness! What no one has yet seen, the fruit: that is protected and indulged and nourished by your whole love. Where your whole love is, with your child, there too is your whole virtue! Your work, your will is your 'neighbour': let no false values persuade you otherwise! 12 You creators, you Higher Men! Whoever has to give birth is sick; but whoever has given birth is unclean. Ask the women: one does not give birth for pleasure. The pain makes hens and poets cackle. You creators, there is much in you that is unclean. That is because you have to be mothers. A new child: oh how much new filth has also entered the world I Go aside I And whoever has given birth should wash his soul clean! 13 Do not be virtuous beyond your powers I And do not ask anything improbable of yourselves! Follow in the footsteps of your fathers' virtue! How would you climb high if the will of your fathers did not climb with you? But he who wants to be a first-born should see that he does not also become a last-born I And you should not pretend to be saints in those matters in which your fathers were vicious! He whose fathers passed their time with women, strong wine, and roast pork, what would it be if he demanded chastity of himself? It would be a piece of folly! Truly, I think it would be much for such a one to be the husband of one or two or three women. And if he founded monasteries and wrote above the doors: 'The way to holiness', I should still say: What of it! it is another piece of folly! He has founded for himself a house of refuge and correction: much good may it do him I But I have no faith in it. It is what one takes into solitude that grows there, the beast within included. And so, many should be dissuaded from solitude. Has there ever been anything filthier on earth than the saints of the desert? Not only the devil was loose around them – but the swine, too. 14 Timid, ashamed, awkward, like a tiger whose leap has failed: this is how I have often seen you slink aside, you Higher Men. A throw you made had failed. But what of that, you dice-throwers! You have not learned to play and mock as a man ought to play and mock! Are we not always seated at a great table for play and mockery? And if great things you attempted have turned out failures, does that mean you yourselves are – failures? And if you yourselves have turned out failures, does that mean – man is a failure? If man has turned out a failure, however: very well! come on! 15 The higher its type, the less often does a thing succeed. You Higher Men here, are you not all – failures? Be of good courage, what does it matter! How much is still possible! Learn to laugh at yourselves as a man ought to laugh! And no wonder you have failed and half succeeded, you half-broken men! Does there not strive and struggle in you -mankind's future? Mankind's most distant, most profound questions, his reaching to the furthest stars, his prodigious power: does all that not foam together in your pot? No wonder many a pot is

shattered! Learn to laugh at yourselves, as a man ought to laugh. You Higher Men, oh how much is still possible! And truly, how much has already succeeded! How rich this earth is in good little perfect things, in well-constituted things! Set good little perfect things around you, you Higher Men! Things whose golden ripeness heals the heart. Perfect things teach hope. 16 What has been the greatest sin here on earth? Was it not the saying of him who said: 'Woe to those who laugh!' Did he himself find on earth no reason for laughter? If so, he sought badly. Even a child could find reasons. He – did not love sufficiently: otherwise he would also have loved us, the laughers I But he hated and jeered at us, he promised us wailing and gnashing of teeth. Does one then straightway have to curse where one does not love? That – seems to me bad taste. But that is what he did, this uncompromising man. He sprang from the mob. And he himself did not love sufficiently: otherwise he would not have been so angry that he was not loved. Great love does not desire love – it desires more. Avoid all such uncompromising men! They are a poor, sick type, a mob type: they look upon this life with an ill will, they have an evil eye for this earth. Avoid all such uncompromising men! They have heavy feet and sultry hearts – they do not know how to dance. How could the earth be light to such men! 17 All good things approach their goal crookedly. Like cats they arch their backs, they purr inwardly at their approaching happiness – all good things laugh. His step betrays whether a man is stepping along his own path: so watch me walk! But he who approaches his goal, dances. And truly, I have not become a statue, I do not stand here stiff, stumpy, stony, a pillar; I love to run fast. And although there are swamps and thick afflictions on earth, he who has light feet runs even across mud and dances as upon swept ice. Lift up your hearts, my brothers, high, higher! And do not forget your legs I Lift up your legs, too, you fine dancers: and better still, stand on your heads! 18 This laugher's crown, this rose-wreath crown: I myself have set this crown on my head, I myself have canonized my laughter. I have found no other strong enough for it today. Zarathustra the dancer, Zarathustra the light, who beckons with his wings, ready for flight, beckoning to all birds, prepared and ready, blissfully light-hearted: Zarathustra the prophet, Zarathustra the laughing prophet, no impatient nor uncompromising man, one who loves jumping and escapades; 51 I myself have set this crown on my head! 19 Lift up your hearts, my brothers, high! higher! And do not forget your legs! Lift up your legs, too, you fine dancers: and better still, stand on your heads! There are beasts who are heavy-footed even in happiness, there are those who are clumsy-footed from birth. They exert themselves strangely, like an elephant trying to stand on its head. But better to be foolish with happiness than foolish with misfortune, better to dance clumsily than to walk lamely. So learn from me my wisdom: even the worst thing has two good sides, even the worst thing has good dancing legs: so learn, you Higher Men, how to stand on your own proper

legs! So unlearn trumpeting of affliction and all mob-sorrowfulness! Oh how sad the Jack Puddings of the mob seem to me at present! This present, however, belongs to the mob. 20 Be like the wind when it rushes forth from its mountain caves: it will dance to its own pipe, the seas tremble and leap under its footsteps. That which gives wings to asses and milks lionesses, all praise to that unruly spirit that comes to all the present and all the mob like a storm-wind, – that is enemy to all thistle-heads and prying noses and to all withered leaves and weeds: all praise to that wild, good, free storm-spirit that dances upon swamps and afflictions as upon meadows! That hates the wasted dogs of the mob and all the ill-constituted brood of gloom: all praise to this spirit of all free spirits, the laughing storm that blows dust in the eyes of all the dim-sighted and ulcerated. You Higher Men, the worst about you is: none of you has learned to dance as a man ought to dance – to dance beyond yourselves! What does it matter that you are failures! How much is still possible! So learn to laugh beyond yourselves! Lift up your hearts, you fine dancers, high! higher! and do not forget to laugh well! This laughter's crown, this rose-wreath crown: to you, my brothers, do I throw this crown! I have canonized laughter; you Higher Men, learn – to laugh! The Song of Melancholy 1 Z ARATHUSTRA was standing near the door of his cave as he spoke this discourse; with the final words, however, he escaped from his guests and fled for a short while into the open air. 'Oh pure odours around me,' he exclaimed, 'oh blissful stillness around me! But where are my animals? Come here, come here, my eagle and my serpent! 'Tell me, my animals: all these Higher Men – do they perhaps not smell well? Oh pure odours around me! Only now do I know and feel how I love you, my animals.' And Zarathustra said again: 'I love you, my animals!' But the eagle and the serpent pressed around him when he said these words, and looked up at him. All three stood silently together in this attitude, and sniffed and breathed in the good air together. For the air here outside was better than with the Higher Men. 2 Hardly had Zarathustra left his cave, however, when the old sorcerer got up, looked cunningly around, and said: He has gone out! And already, you Higher Men – if I may tickle you with this name of praise and flattery, as he does – already my evil spirit of deceit and sorcery attacks me, my melancholy devil, who is an adversary of this Zarathustra from the very heart: forgive him for it! Now he insists on working charms before you, now he has his hour; I wrestle in vain with this evil spirit. To all of you, whatever honours you may bestow upon yourselves with words, whether you call yourselves 'the free spirits' or 'the truthful' or 'the penitents of the spirit' or 'the unfettered' or 'the great desirers', to all of you, like me, suffer from the great disgust, for whom the old God has died and as yet no new God lies in cradles and swaddling clothes – to all of you is my evil spirit and sorcery-devil well-disposed. I know you, Higher Men, I know him – I also know this demon whom I love despite myself, this Zarathustra: he himself often seems to

me like the beautiful mask of a saint, like a strange, new masquerade in which
 my evil spirit, the melancholy devil, takes pleasure – I love Zarathustra, so I
 often think, for the sake of my evil spirit. But already he is attacking me and
 compelling me, this spirit of melancholy, this evening-twilight devil: and truly,
 you Higher Men, he has a desire – just open your eyes! – he has a desire to come
 naked, whether as man or woman I do not yet know: but he is coming, he is
 compelling me, alas! Open your senses! Day is fading away, now evening is
 coming to all things, even to the best things; listen now, and see, you Higher
 Men, what devil, whether man or woman, this spirit of evening melancholy is!
 Thus spoke the old sorcerer, looked cunningly around and then seized his harp. 3
 When the air grows clear, When the dew's comfort Rains down upon the earth,
 Invisible and unheard - For dew the comforter Wears tender shoes like all that
 gently comforts: Do you then remember, do you, hot heart, How once you
 thirsted For heavenly tears and dew showers, Thirsted, scorched and weary,
 While on yellow grassy paths Wicked evening sunlight-glances Ran about you
 through dark trees, Blinding, glowing sunlight-glances, malicious? 'The wooer
 of truth? You?' – so they jeered - 'No! Only a poet! An animal, cunning, preying,
 creeping, That has to lie, That knowingly, wilfully has to lie: Lusting for prey,
 Motley-masked, A mask to itself, A prey to itself - That – the wooer of truth? No!
 Only a fool! Only a poet! Only speaking motley, Crying out of fools-masks,
 Stalking around on deceitful word-bridges, On motley rainbows, Between a false
 heaven And a false earth, Soaring, hovering about - Only a fool! Only a poet!
 That – the wooer of truth? Not still, stiff, smooth, cold, Become an image,
 Become a god's statue, Not set up before temples, A god's watchman: No! enemy
 to such statues of truth, More at home in any wilderness than before temples,
 Full of cat's wantonness, Leaping through every window, Swiftly! into every
 chance, Sniffing out every jungle, Sniffing with greedy longing, That you may
 run, Sinfully-healthy and motley and fair, In jungles among motley-speckled
 beasts of prey, Run with lustful lips, Happily jeering, happily hellish, happily
 blood-thirsty, Preying, creeping, lying: Or like the eagle staring Long, long into
 abysses, Into its abysses: Oh how they circle down, Under and in, Into ever
 deeper depths! Then, Suddenly, with straight aim, Quivering flight, They pounce
 on lambs, Headlong down, ravenous, Lusting for lambs, Angry at all lamb-souls,
 Fiercely angry at all that look. Sheepish, lamb-eyed, curly-wooled, Grey with
 lamb-sheep kindness! Thus, Eagle like, panther like, Are the poet's desires, Are
 your desires under a thousand masks, You fool! You poet! You saw man As God
 and sheep: To rend the God in man As the sheep in man, And in rending to laugh
 - That, that is your blessedness! A panther's and eagle's blessedness! A poet's and
 fool's blessedness!' When the air grows clear, When the moon's sickle Creeps
 along, green, Envious, in the purple twilight: Enemy to day, With every step
 secretly Sickling down The hanging rose-gardens, Until they sink, Sink down,

pale, down to night: So sank I once From my delusion of truth, From my daytime longings, Weary of day, sick with light, Sank downwards, down to evening, down to shadows: Scorched and thirsty With one truth: Do you remember, do you, hot heart, How you thirsted then? That I am banished From all truth, Only a fool! Only a poet! Of Science T HUS sang the sorcerer; and all who were present went like birds unawares into the net of his cunning and melancholy voluptuousness. Only the conscientious man of the spirit was not captured: he quickly snatched the harp away from the sorcerer and cried: 'Air! Let in good air! Let Zarathustra in! You are making this cave sultry and poisonous, you evil old sorcerer! 'You seduce to unknown desires and wildernesses, you false, subtle man. And alas, when such as you chatter and make ado about truth! 'Woe to all free spirits who are not on their guard against such sorcerers! Their freedom is done with: you teach and lure back into prisons, 'you old melancholy devil, a luring bird-call sounds from your lamenting, you are like those who with their praise of chastity secretly invite to voluptuousness!' Thus spoke the conscientious man of the spirit; the old sorcerer, however, looked around him, enjoyed his victory, and on that account swallowed the displeasure the conscientious man had caused him. 'Be quiet!' he said in a modest voice, 'good songs want to echo well; one should be long silent after good songs. 'That is what all of them are doing, these Higher Men. But you, perhaps, have understood little of my song? There is little of the spirit of sorcery in you.' 'You praise me', replied the conscientious man, 'when you separate me from yourself. Very well! But you others, what do I see? You are all sitting there with lustful eyes: 'You free souls, where has your freedom fled! You almost seem like men who have been gazing long at wicked girls dancing naked: your very souls are dancing! 'There must be more of that which the sorcerer called his evil spirit of sorcery and deceit in you, you Higher Men -we must surely be different. 'And truly, we talked and thought together enough, before Zarathustra came home to his cave, for me to know: we are different. 'We seek different things – even up here, you and I. For I seek more security , that is why I came to Zarathustra. For he is still the surest tower and will ' – today, when everything is tottering, when all the earth quakes. But you, when I see what eyes you make, almost seem to me to be seeking more insecurity, 'more horror, more danger, more earthquaking. You have a desire, I almost think, forgive me my presumption, you Higher Men, 'you have a desire for the worst, most dangerous kind of life that terrifies me the most, for the life of wild animals, for the forests, caves, steep mountains, and labyrinths. 'And it is not those who lead out of danger that please you best, but those who lead you astray from all paths, the misleaders. But if you actually harbour such desires, they seem to me, nevertheless, to be impossible. 'For fear – that is man's original and fundamental sensation; everything is explained by fear, original sin and original virtue. From fear grew also my virtue, which is called:

science. 'For fear of wild animals – that has been fostered in man the longest, including the animal he hides and fears within himself- Zarathustra calls it "the beast within". 'This protracted, ancient fear at length grown subtle, spiritual, intellectual – today, it seems to me, it is called: science .' Thus spoke the conscientious man; but Zarathustra, who had just come back to his cave and had heard and understood the last discourse, threw the conscientious man a handful of roses and laughed at his 'truths'. 'What,' he cried, 'what did I just hear? Truly, I think you are a fool, or I myself am one: and I shall straightway stand your "truth" on its head. 'For fear – is the exception with us. Courage, however, and adventure and joy in the unknown, the unattempted – courage seems to me the whole pre-history of man. 'He has envied the wildest, most courageous animals all their virtues and robbed them of them: only thus did he become – man. 'This courage, at length grown subtle, spiritual, intellectual, this human courage with eagle's wings and serpent's wisdom: this , it seems to me, is today called – ' 'Zarathustra !' all those sitting together cried as if from a single mouth and burst into a great peal of laughter; and it was as if a heavy cloud had risen from off them. Even the sorcerer laughed and said prudently: 'Well! My evil spirit has departed! 'And did I myself not warn you against him, when I said he was a deceiver, a spirit of deceit and lies? 'And especially when he shows himself naked. But how can I prevent his pranks I Did I create him and the world? 'Very well! Let us be good again and of good cheer I And although Zarathustra looks ill-temperedly – just see him! he is angry with me: 'before night comes he will again learn to love and praise me, he cannot live long without committing such follies. 'He – loves his enemies: he understands this art better than anyone I have seen. But he takes revenge for that – on his friends!' Thus spoke the old sorcerer, and the Higher Men applauded him: so that Zarathustra went round and mischievously and lovingly shook hands with his friends, like one who has to make amends and apologize to everyone for something. As he came to the door of his cave, however, he already felt again a desire for the good air outside and for his animals, and he was about to slip out. Among the Daughters of the Desert 1 Do not go! (said then the wanderer who called himself Zarathustra's shadow) stay with us, otherwise the old, dull affliction may again assail us. That old sorcerer has already done his worst for our benefit, and just look, the good, pious pope there has tears in his eyes and has again embarked on the sea of melancholy. These kings there may still put on a brave face before us: for they have learned that better than any of us today! But had they no witnesses, I wager that with them, too, the bitter business would begin again – the bitter business of drifting clouds, of damp melancholy, of veiled skies, of stolen suns, of howling autumn winds, the bitter business of our howling and cries of distress: stay with us, O Zarathustra! Here there is much hidden misery that wants to speak out, much evening, much cloud, much damp air! You have fed us with strong man's

fare and nourishing sayings: do not let us, for dessert, be assailed again by delicate, effeminate spirits! You alone make the air around you robust and clear I Have I ever found on earth such good air as with you in your cave? I have seen many lands, my nose has learned to test and appraise many kinds of air: but with you my nostrils taste their greatest delight! Except, except – oh forgive an old memory! Forgive me an old after-dinner song that I once composed among the daughters of the desert - for with them there was the same good, clear, oriental air; there I was farthest away from cloudy, damp, melancholy Old Europe! In those days I loved such oriental girls and other blue kingdoms of heaven, over which no clouds and no thoughts hung. You would not believe how prettily they sat there when they were not dancing, deep but without thoughts, like little secrets, like ribboned riddles, like after-dinner nuts - motley and strange indeed! but without clouds: riddles that one can read: to please such girls I then devised an after-dinner psalm. Thus spoke the wanderer and shadow; and before anyone could answer him he had seized the old sorcerer's harp, crossed his legs, and looked calmly and sagely about him -with his nostrils, however, he drew in the air slowly and inquiringly, like someone tasting strange air in strange lands. Thereupon he began to sing with a kind of roaring. 2 Deserts grew: woe to him who harbours deserts Ha! Solemnly! Solemnly indeed! A worthy beginning! Solemnly in an African way! Worthy of a lion Or of a moral screech-ape – but it is nothing for you, You desert maidens, At whose feet I, For the first time, A European under palm-trees, Am permitted to sit. Selah. Wonderful, truly! Here I now sit, Beside the desert, and Yet so far from the desert, And in no way devastated: For I am swallowed down By this smallest oasis: – it simply opened, yawning, Its sweetest mouth, The sweetest-smelling of all little mouths: Then I fell in, Down, straight through – among you, You dearest maidens! Selah. All hail to that whale If it made things so pleasant For its guests! – you understand My learned allusion? All hail to his belly If it was As sweet an oasis-belly As this is: which, however, I call in question, – since I come from Europe, Which is more sceptical than Any little old wife. May God improve it! Amen! Here I now sit In this smallest oasis Like a date, Brown, sweet, oozing golden, Longing for a girl's rounded mouth, But longing more for girlish, Ice-cold, snow-white, cutting Teeth: for these do The hearts of all hot dates lust. Selah. Like, all too like That aforesaid southern fruit Do I lie here, by little Flying insects Sniffed and played around, And by even smaller, More foolish and more sinful Wishes and notions, Besieged by you, You silent girl-kittens Full of misgivings, Dudu and Suleika, Sphinxed round , that I may cram Much feeling into two words: (May God forgive me This sin of speech!) I sit here sniffing the finest air, Air of Paradise, truly, Bright, buoyant air, gold-streaked, As good air as ever Fell from the moon - Came it by chance, Or did it happen by wantonness, As the old poets tell? I, doubter, however, call it In question; since I come From Europe, Which is more

sceptical than any Little old wife. May God improve it I Amen. Drinking in the fairest air, With nostrils swollen like goblets, Without future, without memories, Thus do I sit here, you Dearest maidens, And regard the palm-tree, And watch how, like a dancer, It bends and bows and sways at the hips, – if one watches long one follows suit! Like a dancer who, it would seem, Has stood long, dangerously long, Always on one little leg? – so that she has forgotten, it would seem, Her other leg? At least, in vain I sought the missing Twin-jewel – that is, the other leg – In the sacred vicinity Of her dearest, daintiest Little fluttering, flickering, fan-swirling skirt. Yes, if you would quite believe me, You sweet maidens: She has lost it! It has gone! Gone for ever! That other leg! Oh, what a shame about that other dear leg! Where can it now be, sorrowing forsaken? That lonely leg? Perhaps in fear before an Angry, blonde-maned Lion-monster? Or perhaps even Gnawed off, broken in pieces - Pitiable, alas! alas! broken in pieces! Selah. Oh do not weep, Gentle hearts! Do not weep, you Date-hearts! Milk-bosoms! You heart-caskets Of sweetwood! Do not weep, Pale Dudu! Be a man, Suleika! Courage! Courage! – Or would perhaps Something bracing, heart-bracing, Be in place here? An anointed proverb? A solemn exhortation? Ha! Up, dignity! Virtuous dignity! European dignity! Blow, blow again, Bellows of virtue! Ha! Roar once again, Roar morally! Roar like a moral lion Before the daughters of the desert! For virtuous howling, You dearest maidens, Is loved best of all by European ardour, European appetite! And here I stand now, As European, I cannot do otherwise, so help me God! 52 Amen! Deserts grow: woe to him who harbours deserts! The Awakening 1 A FTER the song of the wanderer and shadow, the cave suddenly became full of noise and laughter: and as the assembled guests were all speaking together and even the ass no longer remained silent in the face of such encouragement, Zarathustra was overcome by a little repugnance and scorn towards his visitors: although, at the same time, he rejoiced at their gaiety. For it seemed to him to be a sign of recovery. So he stole out into the open air and spoke with his animals. ‘Where is their distress now?’ he said, and already he was breathing again after his little disgust, ‘it seems that in my home they have unlearned distressful crying! ‘although, unhappily, not yet crying itself.’ And Zarathustra stopped his ears, for just then the ‘Ye-a’ of the ass mingled strangely with the loud rejoicing of these Higher Men. ‘They are merry,’ he began again,’ and, who knows, perhaps at the expense of their host. And if they have learned laughing from me, still it is not my laughter they have learned. ‘But what of it! They are old men: they recover in their own way, they laugh in their own way; my ears have suffered worse things and not been annoyed. ‘This day is a victory: it wavers already, it flees, the Spirit of Gravity , my old arch-enemy I How well this day is ending, that began so ill and so gravely! ‘And it is ending. Evening has already come: it is riding over the sea to us; that excellent horseman! How it sways, joyfully returning, in its purple saddle! ‘The sky gazes,

clear, upon it, the world lies deep: O all you strange men who have come to me, it is already worth while to live with me! Thus spoke Zarathustra. And then the shouting and laughter of the Higher Men again came from the cave: it had started again. 'They are biting, my bait is effective, before them too their enemy, the Spirit of Gravity, is wavering. Already they are learning to laugh at themselves: do I hear aright? 'My man's fare, my succulent and strengthening discourse, is effective: and truly, I did not feed them with distending vegetables! But with warriors' food, with conquerors' food: I awakened new desires. 'There are new hopes in their arms and legs, their hearts are stretching themselves. They are discovering new words, soon their spirits will breathe wantonness. 'To be sure, such food may not be for children, or for fond little women, old or young. Their stomachs are persuaded otherwise; I am not their teacher and physician. 'These Higher Men's disgust is wavering: very well! that is my victory. They are growing assured in my kingdom, all stupid shame is leaving them, they are unburdening themselves. 'They are unburdening their hearts, good hours are coming back to them, they take their ease and ruminate – they grow thankful. 'This I take for the best sign: they grow thankful. Before long they will be devising festivals and erecting memorials to their old joys. 'They are convalescents !' Thus spoke Zarathustra gaily to his heart and gazed out; his animals, however, pressed around him and respected his happiness and his silence. 2 But suddenly Zarathustra's ear was startled: for the cave, which had been full of noise and laughter, all at once became deathly still; his nose, however, smelt a sweet-smelling vapour and incense, as if of burning pine-cones. 'What is happening? What are they doing?' he asked himself, and stole to the entrance, so that he might behold his guests unobserved. But, wonder upon wonders! what did he then see with his own eyes! 'They have all become pious again, they are praying, they are mad!' he said, and was astounded beyond measure. And indeed, all these Higher Men, the two kings, the retired pope, the evil sorcerer, the voluntary beggar, the wanderer and shadow, the old prophet, the conscientious man of the spirit, and the ugliest man: they were all kneeling like children and credulous old women, and worshipping the ass. And at that very moment the ugliest man began to gurgle and snort, as if something unutterable was trying to get out of him; but when he actually reached the point of speech, behold, it was a strange, pious litany in praise of the worshipped and perfumed ass. The litany went thus: Amen! And praise and honour and wisdom and thanks and glory and strength be to our God for ever and ever! The ass, however, brayed 'Ye-a'. He bears our burden, he has taken upon himself the likeness of a slave, he is patient from the heart and he never says Nay; and he who loves his God, chastises him. The ass, however, brayed 'Ye-a'. He does not speak, except always to say Yea to the world he created: thus he praises his world. It is his subtlety that does not speak: thus he is seldom thought wrong. The ass, however,

brayed 'Ye-a'. He goes through the world unpretentiously. Grey is the favourite colour 53 in which he wraps his virtue. If he has spirit, he conceals it; but everyone believes in his long ears. The ass, however, brayed 'Ye-a'. What hidden wisdom it is, that he wears long ears and says only Yea and never Nay! Has he not created the world after his own image, that is, as stupid as possible? The ass, however, brayed 'Ye-a'. You go straight and crooked ways; you care little what we men think straight or crooked. Your kingdom is beyond good and evil. It is your innocence not to know what innocence is. The ass, however, brayed 'Ye-a'. For behold, how you spurn no one, not beggars nor kings. You suffer little children to come to you, and when bad boys bait you, you simply say Yea. The ass, however, brayed 'Ye-a'. You love she-asses and fresh figs, you eat anything. A thistle titillates your heart, if you happen to be hungry. The wisdom of a god is in that. The ass, however, brayed 'Ye-a'. The Ass Festival 1 A T this point in the litany, however, Zarathustra could no longer master himself; he cried out 'Ye-a' louder even than the ass, and sprang into the midst of his guests gone mad. 'But what are you doing, my friends?' he cried, pulling the worshippers up from the ground. 'Woe to you if anyone else but Zarathustra had seen you. 'Everyone would adjudge you, with your new faith, to be the worst blasphemers or the most foolish of old women! 'And you, old pope, how can you reconcile yourself to worshipping an ass as God in this way?' 'O Zarathustra,' answered the pope, 'forgive me, but in divine matters I am even more enlightened than you. That stands to reason. 'Better to worship God in this shape than in no shape at all! Consider this saying, my exalted friend: you will quickly see that there is wisdom in such a saying. 'He who said "God is a spirit" took the biggest step and leap towards unbelief yet taken on earth: such a saying is not easily corrected! 'My old heart leaps and bounds to know that there is something left on earth to worship. Forgive a pious old pope's heart that, O Zarathustra!' 'And you,' said Zarathustra to the wanderer and shadow, 'you call and think yourself a free spirit? And do you carry on here such priestly idolatries? 'Truly, you behave here even worse than you did with your wicken brown maidens, you evil new believer!' 'It is bad enough,' answered the wanderer and shadow, 'you are right: but what can I do! The old God lives again, O Zarathustra, you may say what you will. 'It is all the fault of the ugliest man: he has awakened him again. And if he says that he once killed him: with gods, death is always only a prejudice.' 'And you,' said Zarathustra, 'you evil old sorcerer, what were you doing? Who in this free age shall believe in you henceforth, if you believe in such godly asinities? 'What you did was a stupidity; how could you, prudent man, do anything so stupid!' 'O Zarathustra,' answered the prudent sorcerer, 'you are right, it was a stupidity, and it was hard enough to do it.' 'And even you,' said Zarathustra to the conscientious man of the spirit, 'just consider, and lay your finger on your nose! For is there nothing here against your conscience? Is your

spirit not too pure for this praying and the exhalations of these devotees?’ ‘There is something in it,’ answered the conscientious man and laid his finger on his nose, ‘there is something in this spectacle which even does my conscience good. ‘I may not believe in God, perhaps: but it is certain that God seems to me most worthy belief in this form. ‘God is supposed to be eternal according to the testimony of the most pious: he who has so much time takes his time. As slow and as stupid as possible: but such a one can in that way go very far, none the less. ‘And he who has too much spirit might well become infatuated with stupidity and folly. Consider yourself, O Zarathustra! ‘You yourself – truly I even you could become an ass through abundance and wisdom. ‘Does a consummate philosopher not like to walk on the most crooked paths? Appearance teaches it, O Zarathustra – your appearance!’ ‘And you yourself, finally,’ said Zarathustra and turned towards the ugliest man, who was still lying on the ground raising his arm up to the ass (for he was giving it wine to drink). ‘Speak, you unutterable creature, what have you been doing? ‘You seem changed, your eyes are glowing, the mantle of the sublime covers your ugliness: what did you do? ‘Is it true what they say, that you have awakened him again? And why? Was he not with reason killed and done away with? ‘You yourself seem awakened: what did you do? Why did you reform? Why were you converted? Speak, you unutterable creature!’ ‘O Zarathustra,’ answered the ugliest man, ‘you are a rogue. ‘Whether he still lives or lives again or is truly dead, which of us two knows that best? I ask you. ‘But one thing I know -1 once learned it from you yourself, O Zarathustra: He who wants to kill most thoroughly – laughs. “One kills, not by anger but by laughter” – that is what you once said. O Zarathustra, you obscure man, you destroyer without anger, you dangerous saint, you are a rogue!’ 2 Then, however, Zarathustra, amazed at such purely roguish answers, leaped back to the door of his cave and, turning towards all his guests, cried in a loud voice: ‘O all you clowns, you buffoons! Why do you pretend and dissemble before me! ‘How the heart of each of you writhed with joy and mischievousness, because you had at last again become as little children, that is, pious, ‘because you at last again behaved as children do, that is, prayed, clasped your hands and said “Dear God”! ‘But now leave this nursery, my own cave, where today every kind of childishness is at home. Come out here and cool your hot childish wantonness and the clamour of your hearts! ‘To be sure: except you become as little children you shall not enter into this kingdom of heaven.’ (And Zarathustra pointed upwards with his hands.) ‘But we certainly do not want to enter into the kingdom of heaven: we have become men, so we want the kingdom of earth ’ 3 And Zarathustra began to speak once more. ‘O my new friends,’ he said, ‘you strange men, you Higher Men, how well you please me now, ‘since you have become joyful again I Truly, you have all blossomed forth: for such flowers as you, I think, new festivals are needed. ‘a little brave nonsense, some divine service and

ass festival, some joyful old Zarathustra-fool, a blustering wind to blow your souls bright. 'Do not forget this night and this ass festival, you Higher Men! You devised that at my home, I take that as a good omen – only convalescents devise such things! 'And if you celebrate it again, this ass festival, do it for love of yourselves, do it also for love of me! And in remembrance of me !' Thus spoke Zarathustra. The Intoxicated Song 1 M EANWHILE, however, one after another had gone out into the open air and the cool, thoughtful night; but Zarathustra himself led the ugliest man by the hand, to show him his nocturnal world and the big, round moon and the silver waterfalls beside his cave. There at last they stood silently together, just a group of old folk, but with comforted, brave hearts and amazed in themselves that it was so well with them on earth; but the mystery of the night drew nearer and nearer their hearts. And Zarathustra thought to himself again: 'Oh, how well they please me now, these Higher Men!' – but he did not say it, for he respected their happiness and their silence. Then, however, occurred the most astonishing thing in that long, astonishing day: the ugliest man began once more and for the last time to gurgle and snort, and when he at last came to the point of speech, behold, a question leaped round and pure from his mouth, a good, deep, clear question, which moved the hearts of all who heard it. 'My assembled friends,' said the ugliest man, 'what do you think? For the sake of this day – I am content for the first time to have lived my whole life. 'And it is not enough that I testify only this much. It is worth while to live on earth: one day, one festival with Zarathustra has taught me to love the earth. "Was that – life?" I will say to death. "Very well! Once more!"' 'My friends, what do you think? Will you not, like me, say to death: "Was that – life? For Zarathustra's sake, very well! Once more!"' Thus spoke the ugliest man; and it was not long before midnight. And what would you think then took place? As soon as the Higher Men had heard his question, they were all at once conscious of their transformation and recovery, and of who had given them these things: then they leaped towards Zarathustra, thanking, adoring, caressing, kissing his hands, each after his own fashion: so that some laughed, some wept. The old prophet, however, danced with pleasure; and even if he was then full of sweet wine, as some narrators believe, he was certainly fuller still of sweet life and had renounced all weariness. There are even those who tell that the ass danced at that time: for not in vain had the ugliest man given it wine to drink. This may be the case, or it may be otherwise; and if in truth the ass did not dance that evening, greater and stranger marvels than the dancing of an ass occurred. In brief, as Zarathustra's saying has it: 'What does it matter!' 2 Zarathustra, however, when this incident with the ugliest man occurred, stood there like one intoxicated: his eyes grew dim, his tongue stammered, his feet tottered. And who could divine what thoughts then passed over Zarathustra's soul? But it seemed that his soul fell back and fled before him and was in remote distances and as if 'upon a high

ridge', as it is written, 'wandering like a heavy cloud between past and future.' But gradually, while the Higher Men were holding him in their arms, he came to himself a little and his hands restrained the adoring and anxious throng; yet he did not speak. All at once, however, he swiftly turned his head, for he seemed to hear something: then he laid a finger to his lips and said: 'Come! ' And at once it grew still and mysterious all around; from the depths, however, there slowly arose the sound of a bell. Zarathustra listened to it, as the Higher Men did; then he laid a finger to his lips a second time and said again: 'Come! Come! Midnight is coming on !' and his voice had altered. But still he did not move from his place: then it grew yet more still and mysterious, and everything listened, even the ass and Zarathustra's animals of honour, the eagle and the serpent, likewise Zarathustra's cave and the great, cool moon and the night itself. Zarathustra, however, laid his hand to his lips for the third time and said: Come! Come! Come! Let us walk now! The hour has come: let us walk into the night 3 You Higher Men, midnight is coming on: so I will say something in your ears, as that old bell says it in my ear, as secretly, as fearfully, as warmly as that midnight-bell tells it to me, which has experienced more than one man: which has already counted your fathers' painful heartbeats -ah! ah! how it sighs! how in dreams it laughs! the ancient, deep, deep midnight! Soft! Soft! Then many a thing can be heard which may not speak by day; but now, in the cool air, when all the clamour of your hearts, too, has grown still, now it speaks, now it is heard, now it creeps into nocturnal, over-wakeful souls: ah! ah! how it sighs! how in dreams it laughs! do you not hear, how secretly, fearfully, warmly it speaks to you, the ancient, deep, deep midnight? O Man! Attend! 4 Woe is me! Where has time fled? Did I not sink into deep wells? The world is asleep Ah! Ah! The dog howls, the moon is shining. I will rather die, die, than tell you what my midnight-heart is now thinking. Now I am dead. It is finished. Spider, why do you spin your web around me? Do you want blood? Ah! Ah! The dew is falling, the hour has come – the hour which chills and freezes me, which asks and asks and asks: 'Who has heart enough for it? ' – who shall be master of the world? Who will say: Thus shall you run, you great and small streams!' – the hour approaches: O man, you Higher Man, attend! this discourse is for delicate ears, for your ears – what does deep midnight's voice contend? 5 I am borne away, my soul dances. The day's task! The day's task! Who shall be master of the world? The moon is cool, the wind falls silent. Ah I Ah! Have you flown high enough? You dance: but a leg is not a wing. You good dancers, now all joy is over: wine has become dregs, every cup has grown brittle, the graves mutter. You have not flown high enough: now the graves mutter: 'Redeem the dead! Why is it night so long? Does the moon not intoxicate us?' You Higher Men, redeem the graves, awaken the corpses! Alas, why does the worm still burrow? The hour approaches, it approaches, the bell booms, the heart still drones, the woodworm, the heart's worm, still burrows.

Alas! The world is deep! 6 Sweet lyre! Sweet lyre! Your sound, your intoxicated, ominous sound, delights me! – from how long ago, from how far away does your sound come to me, from a far distance, from the pools of love! You ancient bell, you sweet lyre! Every pain has torn at your heart, the pain of a father, the pain of our fathers, the pain of our forefathers; your speech has grown ripe, ripe like golden autumn and afternoon, like my hermit's heart – now you say: The world itself has grown ripe, the grapes grow brown, now they want to die, to die of happiness. You Higher Men, do you not smell it? An odour is secretly welling up, a scent and odour of eternity, an odour of roseate bliss, a brown, golden wine odour of ancient happiness, of intoxicated midnight's dying happiness, which sings: The world is deep: deeper than day can comprehend 7 Let me be! Let me be! I am too pure for you. Do not touch me! Has my world not just become perfect? My skin is too pure for your hands. Let me be, stupid, doltish, stifling day! Is midnight not brighter? The purest shall be master of the world; the least known, the strongest, the midnight souls, who are brighter and deeper than any day. O day, do you grope for me? Do you feel for my happiness? Do you think me rich, solitary, a pit of treasure, a chamber of gold? O world, do you desire me? Do you think me worldly? Do you think me spiritual? Do you think me divine? But day and world, you are too clumsy, have cleverer hands, reach out for deeper happiness, for deeper unhappiness, reach out for some god, do not reach out for me: my unhappiness, my happiness is deep, you strange day, but yet I am no god, no divine Hell: deep is its woe, 8 God's woe is deeper, you strange world I Reach out for God's woe, not for me! What am I? An intoxicated, sweet lyre – a midnight lyre, a croaking bell which no one understands but which has to speak before deaf people, you Higher Men! For you do not understand me! Gone! Gone! Oh youth! Oh noontide! Oh afternoon! Now come evening and midnight; the dog howls, the wind: is the wind not a dog? It whines, it yelps, it howls. Ah! Ah! how it sighs! how it laughs, how it rasps and gasps, the midnight hour! How it now speaks soberly, this intoxicated poet! perhaps it has overdrunk its drunkenness? perhaps it has grown over-wakeful? perhaps it ruminates? it ruminates upon its woe in dreams, the ancient, deep midnight hour, and still more upon its joy. For joy, though woe be deep: Joy is deeper than heart's agony 9 You grape-vine! Why do you praise me? For I cut you! I am cruel, you bleed: what means your praise of my intoxicated cruelty? 'What has become perfect, everything ripe – wants to die!' thus you speak. Blessed, blessed be the vine-knife! But everything unripe wants to live: alas! Woe says: 'Fade! Be gone, woe!' But everything that suffers wants to live, that it may grow ripe and merry and passionate, passionate for remoter, higher, brighter things. 'I want heirs,' thus speaks everything that suffers, 'I want children, I do not want myself.' Joy, however, does not want heirs or children, joy wants itself, wants eternity, wants recurrence, wants everything eternally the same. Woe says: 'Break, bleed, heart!

Walk, legs! Wings, fly! Upward! Upward, pain!' Very well! Come on! my old heart: Woe says: Fade! Go! 10 What do you think, you Higher Men? Am I a prophet? A dreamer? A drunkard? An interpreter of dreams? A midnight bell? A drop of dew? An odour and scent of eternity? Do you not hear it? Do you not smell it? My world has just become perfect, midnight is also noonday, pain is also joy, a curse is also a blessing, the night is also a sun – be gone, or you will learn: a wise man is also a fool. Did you ever say Yes to one joy? O my friends, then you said Yes to all woe as well. All things are chained and entwined together, all things are in love; if ever you wanted one moment twice, if ever you said: 'You please me, happiness, instant, moment!' then you wanted everything to return I you wanted everything anew, everything eternal, everything chained, entwined together, everything in love, O that is how you loved the world, you everlasting men, loved it eternally and for all time: and you say even to woe: 'Go, but return!' For all joy wants -eternity! 11 All joy wants the eternity of all things, wants honey, wants dregs, wants intoxicated midnight, wants graves, wants the consolation of graveside tears, wants gilded sunsets, what does joy not want! it is thirstier, warmer, hungrier, more fearful, more secret than all woe, it wants itself; it bites into itself, the will of the ring wrestles within it, it wants love, it wants hatred, it is superabundant, it gives, throws away, begs for someone to take it, thanks him who takes, it would like to be hated; so rich is joy that it thirsts for woe, for Hell, for hatred, for shame, for the lame, for the world – for it knows, oh it knows this world! You Higher Men, joy longs for you, joy the intractable, blissful – for your woe, you ill-constituted! All eternal joy longs for the ill-constituted. For all joy wants itself, therefore it also wants heart's agony I O happiness! O pain! Oh break, heart! You Higher Men, learn this, learn that joy wants eternity, joy wants the eternity of all things, wants deep, deep, deep eternity! 12 Have you now learned my song? Have you divined what it means? Very well! Come on! You Higher Men, now sing my roundelay! Now sing yourselves the song whose name is 'Once more', whose meaning is 'To all eternity!' – sing, you Higher Men, Zarathustra's roundelay! O Man! Attend! What does deep midnight's voice contend? 'I slept my sleep, 'And now awake at dreaming's end: 'The world is deep, 'Deeper than day can comprehend. 'Deep is its woe, 'Joy – deeper than heart's agony: 'Woe says: Fade! Go! 'Bat all joy wants eternity, 'Wants deep, deep, deep eternity!' The Sign O N the morning after this night, however, Zarathustra sprang up from his bed, girded his loins, and emerged from his cave, glowing and strong, like a morning sun emerging from behind dark mountains. 'Great star,' he said, as he had said once before, 'you profound eye of happiness, what would all your happiness be if you did not have those for whom you shine! 'And if they remained in their rooms while you were already awake and had come, giving and distributing: how angry your proud modesty would be! 'Very well! they are still asleep, these Higher Men,

while I am awake: they are not my rightful companions! It is not for them I am waiting in my mountains. 'I want to go to my work, to my day: but they do not understand what are the signs of my morning, my step -is no awakening call for them. 'They are still sleeping in my cave, their dream still drinks at my intoxicated songs. Yet the ear that listens to me , the obeying ear, is missing from them.' Zarathustra had said this to his heart when the sun rose: then he looked inquiringly aloft, for he heard above him the sharp cry of his eagle. 'Very well!' he cried up, 'so do I like it, so do I deserve it. My animals are awake, for I am awake. 'My eagle is awake and, like me, does honour to the sun. With eagle's claws it reaches out for the new light. You are my rightful animals: I love you. 'But I still lack my rightful men!' Thus spoke Zarathustra; then, however, he suddenly heard that he was surrounded by countless birds, swarming and fluttering – the whirring of so many wings and the throng about his head, however, were so great that he shut his eyes. And truly, it was as if a cloud had fallen upon him, a cloud of arrows discharged over a new enemy. And behold, in this case it was a cloud of love, and over a new friend. 'What is happening to me?' thought Zarathustra, in his astonished heart, and slowly lowered himself on to the great stone that lay beside the exit of his cave. But, as he was clutching about, above and underneath himself, warding off the tender birds, behold, then something even stranger occurred: for in doing so he clutched unawares a thick, warm mane of hair; at the same time, however, a roar rang out in front of him – the gentle, protracted roar of a lion. 'The sign has come ' said Zarathustra, and his heart was transformed. And in truth, when it grew clear before him, there lay at his feet a fallow, powerful animal that lovingly pressed its head against his knee and would not leave him, behaving like a dog that has found his old master again. The doves, however, were no less eager than the lion with their love; and every time a dove glided across the lion's nose, the lion shook its head and wondered and laughed. While this was happening, Zarathustra said but one thing: 'My children are near, my children ' then he grew quite silent. His heart, however, was loosened, and tears fell from his eyes down upon his hands. And he no longer paid attention to anything, and sat there motionless and no longer warding off the animals. Then the doves flew back and forth and sat upon his shoulder and fondled his white hair and did not weary of tenderness and rejoicing. The mighty lion, however, continually licked the tears that fell down upon Zarathustra's hands, roaring and growling shyly as he did so. Thus did these animals. All this lasted a long time, or a short time: for, properly speaking, there is no time on earth for such things. In the meantime, however, the Higher Men in Zarathustra's cave had awakened and arranged themselves for a procession, that they might go to Zarathustra and offer him their morning greeting: for they had discovered when they awoke that he was no longer among them. But when they reached the door of the cave, and the sound of their steps

preceded them, the lion started violently, suddenly turned away from Zarathustra, and leaped up to the cave, roaring fiercely; the Higher Men, however, when they heard its roaring, all cried out as with a single throat and fled back and in an instant had vanished. But Zarathustra himself, bewildered and spell-bound, raised himself from his seat, gazed about him, stood there amazed, questioned his heart, recollected, and saw he was alone. 'What was it I heard?' he slowly said at last, 'what has just happened to me?' And at once his memory returned and he comprehended in a glance all that had happened between yesterday and today. 'This here is the stone,' he said and stroked his beard, 'on this did I sit yesterday morning; and here did the prophet come to me, and here I first heard the cry which I heard even now, the great cry of distress. 'O you Higher Men, it was of your distress that old prophet prophesied to me yesterday morning, 'he tried to seduce and tempt me to your distress: O Zarathustra, he said to me, I have come to seduce you to your ultimate sin. 'To my ultimate sin?' cried Zarathustra and laughed angrily at his own words. 'What has been reserved for me as my ultimate sin?' And once more Zarathustra became absorbed in himself and sat himself again on the great stone and meditated. Suddenly, he leaped up - 'Pity! Pity for the Higher Man !' he cried out, and his countenance was transformed into brass. 'Very well! That - has had its time! 'My suffering and my pity - what of them! For do I aspire after happiness? I aspire after my work! 'Very well! The lion has come, my children are near, Zarathustra has become ripe, my hour has come! 'This is my morning, my day begins: rise up now, rise up, great noontide!' Thus spoke Zarathustra and left his cave, glowing and strong, like a morning sun emerging from behind dark mountains.

NOTES 1. Untergeben has three meanings: to descend or go down; to set (as of the sun); and to be destroyed or to go under. There is much play upon this triple meaning throughout the book. The noun Untergang is treated in a similar way. 2. Übergang und Untergang . The antithesis über (over) and unter (under) is very frequently employed. It is not always possible to bring this out fully in translation. 3. Rede = discourse; Vorrede = prologue. The play on words is lost in translation. 4. Breeber = breaker; Verbrecher normally = criminal. 'Law-breaker' retains the verbal repetition. 5. Hintenveltler is a coinage meaning 'those who believe in an after life'. It gains force from its similarity to the word Hinter-wäldler = backwoodsmen. 6 . The Danish writer Soren Kierkegaard (1813-55), who advocated a return to Christianity by means of a 'leap' from unbelief into belief, is perhaps being criticized here. Much in this chapter reads like a refutation of Kierkegaard. 7 . The phrase derives from the expression Mit dem Kopfe durch die Wand wollen = to run full tilt at everything. 8. Geist means spirit, mind, and intellect - the human understanding. I have generally rendered it as spirit because this seems to me to include intellect and mind while intellect is too narrow in meaning and understanding too cumbrous for the contexts in which Geist occurs. In Thus

Spoke Zarathustra, Geist never has any supernatural connotation. Where spirit in the sense of soul (Seele) is intended, I have used the word soul. 9. Denken = to think, bedenklich = suspicious – a neat play upon words lost in translation. 10 . The people referred to are the Persians. The two following are the Jews and the Germans. 11. Nächsten = neighbour and nearest, and throughout this chapter Ferruten (= the most distant), the opposite of nearest, is also made to mean the opposite of neighbour, i.e. the people of the most distant future. Hence the continual antithesis between “neighbour” and ‘most distant’ – an antithesis not quite so clear in translation as in the original. 12 . An untranslatable pun. ‘To give a person a paw’ means to strike him across the hand with a cane. 13 . There is a play upon words here that can hardly be transmitted in translation. ‘Nicht nur fort sollst du dich pflanzen, sondern binauf!’ ‘Fortpflanzen’ means to propagate (biological) and to trans plant (botanical); ‘binpflanzen’ means to plant out (in the sense of planting out cuttings from a single, original plant). The sentence means: You should not only propagate yourself, transplant your self in the future just as you are; you should see to it that your children are something higher and less confined than you. 14 . The reference is to the first line of the final verse of Goethe’s Faust Part Two: All that is transitory is but an image. See also note 19. 15 . In German gerecht (just) and gerächt (revenged) are pronounced identically. 16. Hoch und steil leben means literally to live in a high and steep place, figuratively to live nobly and boldly. 17. Blicke = glances; Augenblicke = moments. But by a quibble ‘Augenblicke’ can be made to mean ‘glances of the eyes’ (Augen — eyes). This word-play is lost in translation. 18 . ‘Doer’ is in German (in this case) Handelnden – giving a play upon the word ‘hand’. 19 .The final ‘Mystic Chorus’ of Goethe’s Faust Part Two is burlesqued in this chapter. Verbal references to it will be clear from the following literal translation: All that is transitory Is but an image; The unattainable Here becomes reality; The indescribable Here it is done! The eternal-womanly Draws up upward! 20. The Wanderer and his Shadow is the title of one of Nietzsche’s books (the Third Part of Human, All Too Human). 21 . The prophet is Arthur Schopenhauer (1788–1860), who also appears in Part Four. 22. Gedanken und Hintergedanken : the antithesis is lost in translation. 23. Bucklichte = hunchback; bucklicht reden = to speak crossly. 24. Grund = ground and reason. The pun is amplified in ‘foreground’ (superficial reasons) and ‘background’ (fundamental reasons). 25 . This scene is a memory from Nietzsche’s childhood. Nietzsche’s father died following a fall, and it seems that Nietzsche was attracted to the scene by the frightened barking of a dog: he found his father lying unconscious. It is not entirely clear why the scene should have been evoked at this point. The most likely suggestion is that Nietzsche at one time thought that events recurred within historical time, and was troubled by the idea that he might meet the same death as his father. (The idea seems to have assumed the nature of an obsession: its

origin probably lay in Nietzsche's fear of madness, which was strengthened by the fact that his father died insane. The insanity was caused by the fall, but Nietzsche was probably doubtful whether the fall did not merely bring to the surface an inherited weakness.) This old idea may have come into the author's mind at this point, and have been included in the text as a cryptic 'history' of the theory of the eternal recurrence. What follows is, of course, symbolic and not actual. 26 . For 'accepted his destiny' the author here uses the idiom 'stood upon his destiny', giving point to the words 'with firm feet', which in translation may seem puzzling. 27. Himmel means both 'sky' and 'heaven'. 28. Von Ohngefähr means 'by chance' – but the author treats the noun as a proper name and ennobles it by adding 'von ', the ordinary designation of nobility. 29 . I have left this paragraph as it stands because a properly idiomatic translation would alter the original more than is justified. Es gibt sich , as well as meaning 'it is given', is employed idiomatically to mean 'it will get better', or simply as the verbal equivalent of a shrug of the shoulders. Es nimmt sich – 'it is taken' – has no such idiomatic connotation, and is employed by the author simply as an (untranslatable) antithesis to es gibt sich. 30 . A pun on the two meanings of Geist – spirit and intellect. 31. Dämmerten – a scornful reference to Wagner's Gotter- dämmerung (The Twilight of the Gods). 32 . The Bray of an ass is rendered in German la (pronounced ee-ah), which sounds and looks very much like Ja = yes. I have adopted Thomas Common's translation of this as 'Ye-a' (the best that can be done, I think). Thomas Common always translates Ja as 'yea', in accordance with the notion that Thus Spoke Zarathustra is mock-Biblical throughout. The author employs this humorous device to great effect in Part Four. 33 . The imagery of this section derives from the saying Waster bat keine Balken = Water is not planked over, Praise the sea but keep on dry land. Im Fluss means 'in flux', but also 'in the river' and 'flowing'. Later in the same section, 'Have not all railings and gangways fallen into the water and come to nothing' refers to the expression ins Wasser fallen , which means to melt away, to come to nothing, as well as, literally, to fall into the water. This method of reducing an abstract idea to a concrete image by means of everyday idioms is of the essence of Nietzsche's art – and one reason why the vividness of his style is often dimmed in translation. 34 . A play upon Vorspiel = prologue, and Beispiel = example. 35 . A play upon Unterbalt = maintenance, and Unterhaltung = entertainment. 36 . A play upon Eheschliessen = marriage contract, and Ehebrechen = literally marriage breaking, usually adultery. The literal meaning of Ehebrechen is played upon in the following paragraphs. 37 . A play upon Versprechen = promise, and Versehen = mistake. The words balance one another because sprechen by itself means 'to speak', and sehen means 'to see'. 38 . A play, frequent in Thus Spoke Zarathustra , upon versuchen = to experiment, to attempt, and suchen = to seek. 39 . A malicious reference to the opening of Act

Three of Wagner's Siegfried, in which the Wanderer (Wotan) calls up Erda, the Earth Mother, from her sleep, and after a fifteen-minute colloquy bids her return to sleep, The style of this whole passage imitates that of the Wanderer's summons. 40. Würgerin is the feminine form of 'strangler' or 'throttler'; but the word also means the 'shrike'. It is in the feminine form because die Sünde = sin, is feminine. 41. A play upon Geduld = patience, and dulden = to endure, to suffer in patience. 42. A play upon two meanings of Probe: 'proof or test' and 'exhibition'. 43. Verstuben means both 'to test' and 'to tempt'. 44. Unter vier Augen gesprochen = between ourselves (literally 'spoken beneath four eyes'). The last pope, however, is blind in one eye. 45. A play upon verfolgen = to persecute, and folgea = to follow. 46. A play upon Suchung = seeking, Heim = home, and Helm- suchung = affliction. 47. Reif means both 'ring' and 'ripe'. 48. Tagedieb (lazy bones) means literally 'thief of daytime'. 49. A play upon the similar sound of deutsch = German, and deutlich = clearly. Deutschreden, used idiomatically, means 'to speak clearly' (compare 'in plain English'). 50. Abendmahl, the word employed here and in the title of the chapter, is an old form of Abendessen, that is, 'supper'. But it is also the normal word for 'Holy Communion', which is of course an imitation of Christ's last meal with his followers, called in English 'The Last Supper'. The pun upon 'supper' and 'Holy Communion' is not translatable, except perhaps in the way I have attempted. 51. A play upon Sprünge = leaps, and Seitensprünge = literally 'side leaps', idiomatically 'escapades'. 52. Ich kann nicht anders, Gott helfe atir! — Luther's famous words before the Diet of Worms. 53. Leib-Farbe means literally 'body colour', but idiomatically 'favourite colour'. * I owe this insight to Mr Marvin Rintala, who in his review of my biography of Nietzsche in The Review of Politics, January 1969, said I had failed to understand in what the essence of Lutheran Pietism consisted, which was true, and then went on to expound it. 'The great petition of the Lord's Prayer,' says Mr Rintala, 'is for Pietists: "Thy will be done"'. This is so much in line with the Christian origin of the conceptions of Zarathustra that I ought to have guessed it even if I did not know it.

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Part VII

Beyond Good and Evil

1886 — Translated by Ian Johnston

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==== Prologue

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==== Friedrich Nietzsche BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL Translated by Ian Johnston, Vancouver Island University, Nanaimo, British Columbia, Canada

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Suppose truth is a woman, what then? Would we not have good reason to suspect that all philosophers, insofar as they were dogmatists, have had a poor understanding of women, that the dreadful seriousness and the awkward pushiness with which they have so far habitually approached truth were clumsy and inappropriate ways to win over a woman? It's clear that she did not allow herself to be won over. And every form of dogmatism nowadays is standing there looking dismayed and disheartened—if it's still standing at all! For there are mockers who assert that they've collapsed, that all dogmatisms are lying on the floor—even worse, that all dogmatisms are at death's door. Speaking seriously, there are good reasons to hope that every dogmatism in philosophy—no matter how solemnly, conclusively, and decisively it has conducted itself—may have been merely a noble and rudimentary childish game, and the time is perhaps very close at hand when people will understand over and over again just what has sufficed to provide the foundation stones for such lofty and unconditional philosophical constructions of the sort dogmatists have erected up to now—any popular superstition from unimaginably long ago (like the superstition of the soul, which even today, in the form of the superstition about the subject and the ego, has still not stopped stirring up mischief), perhaps some game with words, a seduction by some grammatical construction, or a daring generalization from very narrow, very personal, very human, all-too-human facts. The philosophies of the dogmatists were, one hopes, only a promise lasting for thousands of years, as astrology was in even earlier times. In its

service, people perhaps expended more work, money, astute thinking, and patience than for any genuine scientific knowledge up to that point. To it and to its “super-terrestrial” claims in Asia and Egypt we owe the grand style of architecture. It seems that in order for all great things to register their eternal demands on the human heart, they first have to wander over the earth as monstrous and frighteningly distorted faces. Dogmatic philosophy has been such a grimace—for example, the Vedanta doctrine in Asia and Platonism in Europe. We should not be ungrateful to them, even though we must also certainly concede that the worst, most protracted, and most dangerous of all errors up to now has been the error of a dogmatist, namely, Plato’s invention of the purely spiritual and of the good as such. But that now has been overcome, and, as Europe breathes a sigh of relief after this nightmare and at least can enjoy a more healthy sleep, those of us whose very task it is to stay awake are the inheritors of all the forces which the struggle against this error has fostered. To speak of the spirit and the good in this way, as Plato did, was, of course, a matter of standing truth on its head and even of denying the fundamental condition of all life, perspective. Indeed, one could, as a doctor, ask, “How did such a disease get to Plato, the most beautiful plant of antiquity? Did the wicked Socrates really corrupt him? Could Socrates have been a corruptor of youth, after all? Did he deserve his hemlock?” But the struggle against Plato, or, to put the matter in a more intelligible way and for “the people,” the fight against the thousands of years of pressure from the Christian church—since Christianity is Platonism for “the people”—created in Europe a splendid tension in the spirit, unlike anything existing on earth before. With such a tensely arched bow, we can from now on shoot for the most distant targets. Naturally, European man experiences this tension as a state of emergency. Already there have been two attempts in the grand style to ease the tension in the bow—the first time with Jesuitism, the second time with the democratic Enlightenment, through which, with the help of freedom of the press and reading newspapers, a state might, in fact, be attained in which the spirit itself is not so easily experienced as “in need”! (Germans invented gunpowder—all honour to them!—but they made up for that when they invented the printing press). But those of us who are neither Jesuits, nor democrats, nor even German enough, we good Europeans and free, very free spirits—we still have the need, the entire spiritual need, and the total tension of its bow! And perhaps we also have the arrow, the work to do, and—who knows?—the target . . . Sils-Maria, Oberengadin, June 1885.

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=== Part 1: On the Prejudices of Philosophers

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=== Friedrich Nietzsche BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL Translated by Ian Johnston, Vancouver Island University, Nanaimo, British Columbia, Canada

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PART ONE ON THE PREJUDICES OF PHILOSOPHERS

1 The will to truth, which is still going to tempt us to many a daring exploit, that celebrated truthfulness of which all philosophers up to now have spoken with respect, what questions this will to truth has already set down before us! What strange, sinister, dubious questions! There is already a long history of that—and yet does it not seem that this history has only just begun? Is it any wonder that at some point we finally become mistrustful, lose patience, and, in our impatience, turn ourselves around—that we learn from this sphinx to ask questions for ourselves? Who is really asking us questions here? What is it in us that really wants “the truth”? In fact, we paused for a long time before the question about the origin of this will—until we finally remained completely and utterly immobile in front of an even more fundamental question. We asked about the value of this will. Suppose we want truth. Why should we not prefer untruth? And uncertainty? Even ignorance? The problem of the value of truth stepped up before us—or were we the ones who stepped up before the problem? Who among us here is Oedipus? Who is the Sphinx?(1) It seems to be a tryst between questions and question marks. And could one believe that we are finally the ones to whom it seems as if the problem has never been posed up to now, as if we were the first ones to see it, to fix our eyes on it, and to dare confront it? For there is a risk involved in this—perhaps there is no greater risk. 2

“How could anything arise out of its opposite? For example, truth out of error? Or the will to truth out of the will to deception? Or selfless action out of self-seeking? Or the pure sunny look of the wise man out of greed? Origins like these are impossible. Anyone who dreams about them is a fool, in fact, something worse. Things of the highest value must have another origin peculiar to them. They cannot be derived from this ephemeral, seductive, deceptive, trivial world, from this confusion of madness and desire! Their basis must lie, by contrast, in the womb of being, in the immortal, in the hidden god, in ‘the thing in itself’—their basis must lie there, and nowhere else!” This way of shaping an argument creates the typical prejudice which enables us to recognize once more the metaphysicians of all ages. This way of establishing value stands behind all their logical procedures. From this “belief” of theirs they wrestle with their “knowledge,” with something that is finally, in all solemnity, christened “the truth.” The fundamental belief of the metaphysicians is the belief in oppositions of values. Even the most careful among them has never had the idea

of raising doubts right here on the threshold, where such doubts are surely most essential, even when they promised themselves “de omnibus dubitandum” [one must doubt everything]. For we are entitled to doubt, first, whether such oppositions exist at all and, second, whether those popular ways of estimating worth and those oppositions of values on which the metaphysicians have impressed their seal are not perhaps only evaluations made in the foreground, only temporary perspectives, perhaps even a view from a corner, perhaps from underneath, a frog’s viewpoint, as it were, to borrow an expression familiar to painters. For all the value that the true, genuine, unselfish person may be entitled to, it might be possible that a higher and more fundamental value for everything in life must be ascribed to appearance, the will to deception, self-interest, and desire. It might even be possible that whatever creates the value of those fine and respected things exists in such a way that it is, in some duplicitous manner, related to, tied to, and intertwined with, perhaps even essentially the same as, those nasty, apparently contrasting things. Perhaps! But who is willing to bother with such dangerous Perhapses? For that we must await the arrival of a new style of philosopher, ones who have a different taste and inclination, the reverse of those so far—philosophers of the dangerous Perhaps, in every sense. And speaking in all seriousness, I see such new philosophers arriving on the scene. 3 After examining philosophers between the lines with a sharp eye for a sufficient length of time, I tell myself the following: we must still consider the greatest part of conscious thinking among the instinctual activities, even in the case of philosophical thinking. We must relearn here, in the same way we relearned about heredity and what is “innate.” Just as the act of birth merits little consideration in all the procedures and processes of heredity, so there is little point in setting up “consciousness” in any significant sense as something opposite to what is instinctual—most of the conscious thinking of a philosopher is led on secretly and forced into particular paths by his instincts. Even behind all logic and its apparent dynamic authority stand evaluations of worth or, putting the matter more clearly, physiological demands for the preservation of a particular way of life—for example, that what is certain is more valuable than what is uncertain, that appearance is of less value than the “truth.” Evaluations like these could, for all their regulatory importance for us, still be only foreground evaluations, a particular kind of *niaiserie* [foolishness] that may be necessary for the preservation of beings precisely like us. That’s assuming, of course, that not just man is the “measure of things” . . . 4 For us, the falsity of a judgment is still no objection to that judgment—that’s where our new way of speaking sounds perhaps most strange. The question is the extent to which it promotes and sustains life, maintains the species, perhaps even creates species. And, as a matter of principle, we are ready to assert that the falsest judgments (to which a priori synthetic judgments belong) are the most indispensable to us, that

without our allowing logical fictions to count, without a way of measuring reality against the purely invented world of the unconditional and self-identical, without a constant falsification of the world through numbers, human beings could not live—that if we managed to give up false judgments, that would amount to a renunciation of life, a denial of life.(2) To accept falsehood as a condition of life means, of course, taking a dangerous stand against the customary feelings about value, and, for this reason alone, a philosophy which dares to do so is already standing beyond good and evil. 5 What stimulates one to look at all philosophers in part suspiciously and in part mockingly is not that we find again and again how innocent they are—how often and how easily they make mistakes and get lost, in short, how childish and child-like they are—but that they are not honest enough in what they do, while, as a group, they make a huge, virtuous noise as soon as the problem of truthfulness is touched on, even remotely. Collectively they take up a position as if they had discovered and arrived at their real opinions through the self-development of a cool, pure, god-like, disinterested dialectic (in contrast to the mystics of all ranks, who are more honest than they are and more stupid with their talk of “inspiration”—), while basically they defend with reasons sought out after the fact an assumed principle, an idea, an “inspiration,” for the most part some heartfelt wish which has been abstracted and sifted. They are all advocates who do not want to call themselves that. Indeed, for the most part they are even mischievous pleaders for their own judgments, which they baptize as “truths,” and very remote from the courage of conscience which would admit this, even this, to itself, very remote from the courageous good taste which would concede as much, whether to warn an enemy or a friend, or whether to mock themselves as an expression of their own high spirits. That equally stiff and well-behaved Tartufferie [hypocrisy] of the old Kant with which he entices us onto the clandestine path of dialectic, leading or, more correctly, seducing us to his “categorical imperative”—this dramatic performance makes us discriminating people laugh, for it amuses us in no small way to keep a sharp eye on the sophisticated scheming of the old moralists and preachers of morality.(3) Or that sort of mathematical hocus-pocus with which Spinoza presented his philosophy—in the last analysis “the love of his own wisdom,” to use the correct and proper expression—as if it were armed in metal and masked, in order in this way to intimidate from the start the courage of an assailant who would dare cast an eye on this invincible virgin and Pallas Athena—how much of his own shyness and vulnerability is betrayed by this masquerade of a solitary invalid!(4) 6 Gradually I have come to learn what every great philosophy has been up to now, namely, the self-confession of its originator and a form of unintentional and unnoticed memoir, and also that the moral (or immoral) intentions in every philosophy made up the essential living seed from which, on every occasion, the entire plant has grown. In fact, when we explain how the most remote

metaphysical claims of a philosopher really arose, it's good (and shrewd) for us always to ask first: What morality is it (is he—) aiming at? Consequently, I don't believe that a "drive to knowledge" is the father of philosophy but that here, as elsewhere, knowledge (and misjudgment) have functioned only as a tool for another drive. But whoever explores the basic drives of human beings, in order to see in this particular place how far they may have carried their game as inspiring geniuses (or demons and goblins), will find that all drives have already practised philosophy at some time or another—and that every single one of them would all too gladly like to present itself as the ultimate purpose of existence and the legitimate master of all the other drives. For every drive seeks mastery and, as such, tries to practise philosophy. Of course, with scholars, men of real scientific knowledge, things may be different—"better," if you will—where there may really be something like a drive for knowledge, some small independent clock mechanism or other which, when well wound up, bravely goes on working, without all the other drives of the scholar playing any essential role. (5) The genuine "interests" of the scholar thus commonly lie entirely elsewhere, for example, in the family or in earning a living or in politics. Indeed, it is almost a matter of indifference whether his small machine is placed on this or on that point in science and whether the "promising" young worker makes a good philologist or expert in fungus or chemist—whether he becomes this or that does not define who he is. With a philosopher, by contrast, nothing at all is impersonal. And his morality, in particular, bears a decisive and crucial witness to who he is—that is, to the rank ordering in which the innermost drives of his nature are placed relative to each other. 7 How malicious philosophers can be! I know nothing more venomous than the joke which Epicurus permitted himself against Plato and the Platonists: he called them Dionysio-kolakes. The literal meaning of that, what stands in the foreground, is "flatterers of Dionysius," hence accessories of tyrants and lickspittles.(6) But the phrase says still more than that—"they are all actors, with nothing true about them" (for Dionysokolax was a popular description of an actor). And that last part is the real maliciousness which Epicurus hurled against Plato: the magnificent manners which Plato, along with his pupils, understood, the way they stole the limelight—things Epicurus did not understand!—that irritated him, the old schoolmaster from Samos, who sat hidden in his little garden in Athens and wrote three hundred books—who knows?—perhaps out of rage and ambition against Plato?—It took a hundred years until Greece came to realize who this garden god Epicurus was.—Did they realize? 8 In every philosophy there is a point where the "conviction" of the philosopher steps onto the stage, or, to make the point in the language of an old mystery play: The ass arrived Beautiful and most valiant.(7) 9 Do you want to live "according to nature"? O you noble Stoics, what a verbal swindle!(8) Imagine a being like nature—extravagant

without limit, indifferent without limit, without purposes and consideration, without pity and justice, simultaneously fruitful, desolate, and unknown—imagine indifference itself as a power—how could you live in accordance with this indifference? Living—isn't that precisely a will to be something different from what this nature is? Isn't living appraising, preferring, being unjust, being limited, wanting to be different? And if your imperative "live according to nature" basically means what amounts to "live according to life"—how could you not do that? Why make a principle out of what you yourselves are and must be? The truth of the matter is quite different: while you pretend to be in raptures as you read the canon of your law out of nature, you want something which is the reverse of this, you weird actors and self-deceivers! Your pride wants to prescribe to and incorporate into nature, this very nature, your morality, your ideal. You demand that nature be "in accordance with the Stoa," and you'd like to make all existence merely living in accordance with your own image—as a huge and eternal glorification and universalizing of Stoicism! With all your love of truth, you force yourselves for such a long time and with such persistence and hypnotic rigidity to look at nature falsely, that is, stoically, until you are no longer capable of seeing nature as anything else—and some abysmal arrogance finally inspires you with the lunatic hope that, because you know how to tyrannize over yourselves—Stoicism is self-tyranny—nature also allows herself to be tyrannized. Is the Stoic then not a part of nature? . . . But this is an ancient, eternal story: what happened then with the Stoics is still happening today, as soon as a philosophy begins to believe in itself. It always creates a world in its own image. It cannot do anything different. Philosophy is this tyrannical drive itself, the most spiritual will to power, to a "creation of the world," to *causa prima* [first cause]. 10 The enthusiasm and the subtlety—I might even say the cunning—with which people everywhere in Europe today go at the problem "of the real and the apparent world" make one think and listen—and whoever hears only a "will to truth" in the background and nothing else certainly does not enjoy the keenest hearing. In single rare cases such a will to truth, some extravagant and adventurous spirit, a metaphysician's ambition to hold an isolated post, may really be involved, something which in the end continues to prefer a handful of "certainty" to an entire wagon full of beautiful possibilities. There may even be Puritan fanatics of conscience who would still rather lie down and die on a certain nothing than on an uncertain something. But this is nihilism and the indication of a despairing, deathly tired soul, no matter how brave the gestures of such virtue may look. But among stronger thinkers, more full of life, still thirsty for life, it appears to be something different. When they take issue with appearances and already in their arrogance mention the word "perspective," when they determine that the credibility of their own bodies is about as low as they rank the credibility of visual evidence which asserts that

“the earth stands still,” and, as a result, in an apparently good mood, let go of their surest possession (for nowadays what do we think is more secure than our bodies?), who knows whether they don’t, at bottom, want to win back something which people previously possessed with even more certainty, something or other of the old ownership of an earlier faith, perhaps “the immortal soul,” perhaps “the old god,” in short, ideas according to which life could be lived better, that is, more powerfully and more cheerfully than according to “modern ideas”? In this, there is a mistrust of these modern ideas, a lack of faith in everything which has been built up yesterday and today, and perhaps a slight mixture of aversion and scorn, which can no longer tolerate the bric-à-brac of ideas coming from very different places, of the sort so-called positivism brings to market these days, a disgust of the more discriminating taste with the fairground colourful patchiness of all these pseudo-philosophers of reality, in whom there is nothing new or genuine, other than these motley colours. In my view, we should, in these matters, side with today’s sceptical anti-realists and microscopists of knowledge: their instinct, which forces them away from modern reality, is unrefuted—what do we care about their retrogressive secret paths! The fundamental issue with them is not that they want to go “back,” but that they want to go away. With some more power, flight, courage, and artistry they’d want to move beyond—and not back! 11 It strikes me that nowadays people everywhere are trying to direct attention away from the real influence Kant exercised on German philosophy and, in particular, prudently to overlook the value he ascribed to himself. Above everything else, Kant was, first and foremost, proud of his table of categories. With this table in hand, he said, “That is the most difficult thing that ever could be undertaken on behalf of metaphysics.”—But people should understand this “could be”! He was proud of the fact that he had discovered a new faculty in human beings, the ability to make synthetic judgments a priori. Suppose that he deceived himself here. But the development and quick blood of German philosophy depend on this pride and on the competition among all his followers to discover, if possible, something even prouder—at all events “new faculties”! But let’s think this over. It’s time we did. “How are synthetic judgments a priori possible?” Kant asked himself. And what did his answer essentially amount to? Thanks to a faculty [Vermöge eines Vermögens]. Unfortunately, however, he did not answer in four words, but so laboriously, venerably, and with such an expenditure of German profundity and flourishes that people failed to hear the comical niaiserie allemande [German foolishness] inherent in such an answer. People even got really excited about this new faculty, and the rejoicing reached its height when Kant discovered yet another additional faculty—a moral faculty—in human beings, for then the Germans were still moral and not yet all complete “political realists.” Then came the honeymoon of German philosophy. All the young theologians of the Tübingen seminary went off right away into the

bushes—all looking for “faculties.” And what didn’t they find—in that innocent, rich, still youthful time of the German spirit, in which Romanticism, that malicious fairy, played her pipes and sang, a time when people did not yet know how to distinguish between “finding” and “inventing”! Above all, a faculty for the “super-sensory.” Schelling christened this intellectual intuition and, in so doing, complied with the most heartfelt yearnings of his Germans, whose cravings were basically pious.(9)—The most unfair thing we can do to this entire rapturously enthusiastic movement, which was adolescent, no matter how much it boldly dressed itself up in gray and senile ideas, is to take it seriously and treat it with something like moral indignation. Enough—people grew older—the dream flew away. There came a time when people rubbed their foreheads. People are still rubbing them today. They had dreamed: first and foremost—the old Kant. “By means of a faculty,” he had said, or at least meant. But is that an answer? An explanation? Or is it not rather merely a repetition of the question? How does opium make people sleep? “By means of a faculty,” namely, the *virtus dormitiva* [sleeping virtue], answers that doctor in Moliere. Because it has the sleeping virtue whose nature makes the senses sleep.(10) But answers like that belong in comedy, and the time has finally come to replace the Kantian question “How are synthetic judgments a priori possible?” with another question, “Why is the belief in such judgments necessary?”—that is, to understand that for the purposes of preserving beings of our type we must believe that such judgments are true, although, of course, they could still be false judgments! Or to speak more clearly, crudely, and fundamentally: synthetic judgments a priori should not “be possible” at all: we have no right to them. In our mouths they are nothing but false judgments. Only, of course, a belief in their truth is necessary as a foreground belief and appearance which belong in the perspective optics of living. In order finally to recall the immense influence which “German philosophy”—you understand, I hope, its right to quotation marks?—has exercised throughout Europe, there should be no doubt that a certain *virtus dormitiva* [virtue of making people sleep] was a part of that: people—among them noble loafers, the virtuous, the mystics, the artists, the three-quarter Christians, and political obscurantists of all nations—were delighted to have, thanks to German philosophy, an antidote to the still overpowering sensualism flowing over from the previous century into this one, in short—to have a “*sensus assoupire*” [way of putting the senses to sleep]. 12 So far as materialistic atomism is concerned, it belongs with the most effectively refuted things we have, and perhaps nowadays in Europe no scholar remains so unscholarly that he still ascribes a serious meaning to it other than for convenient hand-and-household use (that is, as an abbreviated way of expressing oneself)—thanks primarily to that Pole Boscovich, who, together with the Pole Copernicus, has so far been the greatest and most victorious opponent of appearances.

(11) For while Copernicus convinced us to believe, contrary to all our senses, that the earth does not stand still, Boscovich taught us to renounce the belief in the final thing on the earth that “stood firm,” the belief in “stuff,” in “matter,” in what was left of the earth, in atomic particles. It was the greatest triumph over the senses ever achieved on earth so far. But we must go even further and also declare war, a relentless war to the bitter end, against the “atomistic need,” which still carries on a dangerous afterlife in places where no one suspects, like that more celebrated “metaphysical need.”—We must first of all get rid of that other and more disastrous atomism, as well, which Christianity has taught best and longest, the atomism of the soul. With this phrase let me be permitted to designate the belief which assumes that the soul is something indestructible, eternal, indivisible—like a monad, like an atomon. We should rid scientific knowledge of this belief! Just between us, it is not at all necessary here to get rid of “the soul” itself and to renounce one of the oldest and most venerable hypotheses, as habitually happens with the clumsiness of the naturalists, who hardly touch upon “the soul” without immediately losing it. But the way to new versions and refinements of the hypothesis of the soul stands open: and ideas like “mortal soul” and “soul as the multiplicity of the subject” and “soul as the social structure of drives and affects” from now on want to have civil rights in scientific knowledge. While the new psychologist is preparing an end to the superstition which so far has flourished with an almost tropical lushness in the way the soul has been imagined, at the same time he has naturally pushed himself, as it were, into a new desert and a new mistrust—it may be the case that the older psychologists had a more comfortable and happier time of it—; finally, however, he knows that in that very process he himself is also condemned to invent, and—who knows?—perhaps to discover. 13 Physiologists should think carefully about setting up the drive to preserve the self as the cardinal drive in an organic being. Above everything else, something living wants to release its power—living itself is will to power. Self-preservation is only one of the indirect and most frequent consequences of that. In short, here as everywhere, beware of all extraneous teleological principles! The drive for self-preservation is one such principle (we have Spinoza’s inconsistency to thank for it—). For that is demanded by the method, which must, in essence, be economy of principles. 14 Nowadays in perhaps five or six heads the idea is dawning that even physics is only an interpretation and explication of the world (for our benefit, if I may be permitted to say so) and not an explanation of the world. But to the extent it rests upon a faith in the senses, it counts for more and must continue to count for more for a long time yet, that is, as an explanation. Physics has eyes and fingers on its side; it has appearance and tangibility on its side. That works magically on an age with basically plebeian taste—persuasively and convincingly—indeed, it follows instinctively the canon of truth of eternally popular sensualism. What is

clear, what is “explained”? Only whatever lets itself be seen and felt—every problem has to be pushed that far. By contrast, the reluctance to accept obvious evidence of the senses constituted the magic of the Platonic way of thinking, which was a noble way of thinking—perhaps among human beings who enjoyed even stronger and more discriminating senses than our contemporaries have, but who knew how to experience a higher triumph in remaining master of these senses and to do this by means of the pale, cool, gray, conceptual nets which they threw over the colourful confusion of sense, the rabble of the senses, as Plato called them. That form of enjoyment in overcoming this world and interpreting the world in the manner of Plato was different from the one which today’s physicists offer us, as well as the Darwinists and anti-teleologists among the physiological workers, with their principle of the “smallest possible force” and the greatest possible stupidity. “Where human beings have nothing more to look at and to grip, there they have also no more to seek out”—that is, of course, an imperative different from the Platonic one, but nonetheless for a coarse, diligent race of mechanics and bridge builders of the future, who have nothing but rough work to do, it might be precisely the right imperative. 15 In order to carry on physiology in good conscience, people must hold to the principle that the sense organs are not phenomena in the sense of idealistic philosophy: as such they could not, in fact, be causes! And so sensualism at least as a regulative hypothesis, if not as a heuristic principle.—What’s that? And other people even say that the outer world is the work of our organs? But then our body, as a part of this outer world, would, in fact, be the work of our organs! But then our organs themselves would, in fact, be—the work of our organs. It seems to me that this is a complete *reductio ad absurdum* [absurd conclusion] provided that the idea of *causa sui* [something being its own cause] is fundamentally absurd. Consequently, is the exterior world not the work of our organs—? 16 There are still harmless observers of themselves who believe that there are “immediate certainties,” for example, “I think,” or that superstition of Schopenhauer’s, “I will,” just as if perception here were able to seize upon its object pure and naked, as the “thing in itself,” and as if there were no falsification either on the part of the subject or of the object.(12) However, the fact is that “immediate certainty,” just as much as “absolute cognition” and “thing in itself,” contains within itself a *contradictio in adjecto* [contradiction in terms]. I’ll repeat it a hundred times: people should finally free themselves from the seduction of words! Let folk believe that knowing is knowing all of something. The philosopher must say to himself, “When I dismantle the process that is expressed in the sentence ‘I think,’ I come upon a series of daring assertions whose rational grounding is difficult, perhaps impossible—for example, that I am the one who thinks, that there must really be something that thinks, that thinking is an action and effect of a being who is to be thought of as a cause, that there is an ‘I’, and finally that it is already

established what we mean by thinking—that I know what thinking is. For if I had not yet decided these questions in myself, how could I assess that what is now happening might not perhaps be ‘willing’ or ‘feeling’?” In short, this “I think” presupposes that I compare my immediate condition with other conditions which I know in myself in order to establish what it is. Because of this referring back to other forms of ‘knowing,’ it certainly does not have any immediate ‘certainty’ for me.” Thus, instead of that “immediate certainty,” which people may believe in the case under discussion, the philosopher encounters a series of metaphysical questions, really essential problems of intellectual knowledge, as follows: “Where do I acquire the idea of thinking? Why do I believe in cause and effect? What gives me the right to speak of an ‘I,’ and indeed of an ‘I’ as a cause, finally even of an ‘I’ as the cause of thinking?” Anyone who ventures to answer those metaphysical questions right away with an appeal to some kind of intuitive cognition, as does the man who says “I think and know that at least this is true, real, and certain”—such a person nowadays will be met by a philosopher with a smile and two question marks. “My dear sir,” the philosopher will perhaps give him to understand, “it is unlikely that you are not mistaken but why such absolute insistence on the truth?”— 17 So far as the superstitions of the logicians are concerned, I will never tire of emphasizing over and over again a small brief fact which these superstitious types are unhappy to concede—namely, that a thought comes when “it” wants to and not when “I” wish, so that it is a falsification of the facts to say that the subject “I” is the condition of the predicate “think.” It thinks: but that this “it” is precisely that old, celebrated “I” is, to put it mildly, only an assumption, an assertion, in no way an “immediate certainty.” After all, we’ve already done too much with this “it thinks”: this “it” already contains an interpretation of the event and is not part of the process itself. Following grammatical habits people conclude here as follows: “Thinking is an activity. To every activity belongs someone who does the action, therefore—.” With something close to this same pattern, the older atomism, in addition to the “force” which created effects, also looked for that clump of matter where the force is located, out of which it works—the atom. Stronger heads finally learned how to cope without this “remnant of earth,” and perhaps one day people, including even the logicians, will also grow accustomed to cope without that little “it” (to which the honest old “I” has reduced itself). 18 It’s true that the fact that a theory can be disproved is not the least of its charms: that’s precisely what attracts more sophisticated minds to it. Apparently the theory of “free will,” which has been refuted hundreds of times, owes its continuing life to this very charm alone—again and again someone or other comes along and feels he’s strong enough to refute it. 19 Philosophers customarily speak of the will as if it were the best-known thing in the world. Indeed, Schopenhauer let it be known that the will is the only thing really known to us, totally known, understood

without anything taken away or added. But still, again and again it seems to me that Schopenhauer, too, in this case has only done what philosophers just do habitually—he's appropriated and exaggerated a popular opinion. Willing seems to me, above all, something complicated, something that is unified only in the word—and popular opinion simply inheres in this one word, which has overmastered the always inadequate caution of philosophers. So if we are, for once, more careful, if we are "un-philosophical," then let's say, firstly, that in every act of willing there is, to start with, a multiplicity of feelings, namely, the feeling of the condition away from which, a feeling of the condition towards which, the feeling of this "away" and "towards" themselves, then again, an accompanying muscular feeling which comes into play through some kind of habit, without our putting our "arms and legs" into motion, as soon as we "will." Secondly, just as we acknowledge feelings, indeed many different feelings, as ingredients of willing, so we should also acknowledge that thinking is an ingredient as well. In every act of will there is a commanding thought, and people should not believe that this thought can be separated from the "will," as if then the will would still be left over! Thirdly, the will is not only a complex of feeling and thinking but, above all, an affect, and, indeed, an affect of the command. What is called "freedom of the will" is essentially the feeling of superiority with respect to the one who has to obey: "I am free; 'he' must obey"—this awareness inheres in every will, as does that tense attentiveness, that direct gaze fixed exclusively on one thing, that unconditional value judgment "Do this now—nothing else needs to be done," that inner certainty about the fact that obedience will take place, and everything else that accompanies the condition of the one issuing commands. A person who wills—gives orders to something in himself that obeys or that he thinks obeys. But now observe what is the strangest thing about the will—about this multifaceted thing for which the people have only a single word: insofar as we are in a given case the one ordering and the one obeying, both at the same time, and as the one obeying we know the feelings of compulsion, of pushing and pressing, resistance and movement, which usually start right after the act of will, and insofar as we, by contrast, have the habit of disregarding this duality and of deceiving ourselves, thanks to the synthetic idea of "I," a whole series of mistaken conclusions and, consequently, of false evaluations of the will itself has attached itself to the act of willing, in such a way that the person doing the willing believes in good faith that willing is sufficient for action. Because in the vast majority of cases a person wills something only where he may expect his command to take effect—that is, in obedience and action—what is apparent has translated itself into a feeling, as if there might be some necessary effect. In short, the one who is doing the willing believes, with a reasonable degree of certainty, that will and action are somehow one thing—he ascribes his success, the carrying out of the willing, to the will

itself and, in the process, enjoys an increase in that feeling of power which all success brings with it. “Freedom of the will”—that’s the expression for the multifaceted condition of enjoyment in the person willing, who commands and, at the same, identifies himself with what is carrying out the order. As such, he enjoys the triumph over things which resist him, but within himself is of the opinion that it is his will by itself which really overcame this resistance. The person doing the willing thus acquires the joyful feelings of the successful implements carrying out the order, the serviceable “under-wills” or under-souls—our body is, in fact, merely a social construct of many souls—in addition to his joyful feeling as the one who commands. *L’effet c’est moi* [The effect is I]. What happens here is what happens in every well-constructed and happy community—the ruling class identifies itself with the successes of the community. All willing is simply a matter of giving orders and obeying, on the basis, as mentioned, of a social construct of many “souls”: for this reason a philosopher should arrogate to himself the right to include willing as such within the field of morality: morality, that is, understood as a doctrine of the relationships of dominance under which the phenomenon “living” arises.²⁰ That individual philosophical ideas are not something spontaneous, not things which grow out of themselves, but develop connected to and in relationship with each other, so that, no matter how suddenly and arbitrarily they may appear to emerge in the history of thought, they nevertheless belong to a system just as much as do the collective members of the fauna of a continent, that point finally reveals itself by the way in which the most diverse philosophers keep filling out again and again a certain ground plan of possible philosophies. Under an invisible spell they always run around the same orbit all over again: they may feel they are still so independent of each other with their critical or systematic wills, but something or other inside leads them, something drives them in a particular order one after the other, namely, that inborn structural arrangement and relationship of ideas. Their thinking is, in fact, much less a discovery than a recognition, a remembering, a return journey back home into a distant primordial collective household of the soul, out of which those ideas formerly grew. To practise philosophy is to this extent a form of atavism of the highest order. The strange family similarity of all Indian, Greek, and German ways of practising philosophy can be explained easily enough. It’s precisely where a relationship between languages is present we cannot avoid the fact that, thanks to the common philosophy of grammar—I mean thanks to the unconscious mastery and guidance exercised by similar grammatical functions—everything has been prepared from the beginning for a similar development and order of philosophical systems, just as the road to certain other possibilities of interpreting the world seems sealed off. There will be a greater probability that philosophers from the region of the Ural-Altaic languages (in which the idea of the subject is most poorly developed) will look differently “into the world” and

will be found on other pathways than Indo-Germans or Muslims: the spell of particular grammatical functions is, in the final analysis, the spell of physiological judgments of value and racial conditions.—So much for the repudiation of Locke’s superficiality in connection with the origin of ideas.(13) 21 The *causa sui* [something being its own cause] is the best self-contradiction that has been thought up so far, a kind of logical rape and perversity. But the excessive pride of human beings has worked to entangle itself deeply and terribly with this very nonsense. The demand for “freedom of the will,” in that superlative metaphysical sense, as it unfortunately still rules in the heads of the half-educated, the demand to bear the entire final responsibility for one’s actions oneself and to relieve God, the world, ancestors, chance, and society of responsibility for them, is really nothing less than this very *causa sui* and a pulling oneself into existence out of the swamp of nothingness by the hair, with more audacity than Munchhausen. Suppose someone in this way gets behind the boorish simplicity of this famous idea of the “free will” and erases it from his head, then I would invite him now to push his “enlightenment” still one step further and erase also the inverse of this non-idea [Unbegriffs] of “free will” from his head: I refer to the “un-free will,” which amounts to an abuse of cause and effect. People should not mistakenly reify “cause” and “effect,” the way those investigating nature do (and people like them who nowadays naturalize their thinking—), in accordance with the ruling mechanistic foolishness which allows the cause to push and shove until it “have an effect.” People should use “cause” and “effect” merely as pure ideas, that is, as conventional fictions to indicate and communicate, not as an explanation. In the “in itself” there is no “causal connection,” no “necessity,” no “psychological un-freedom,” no “effect following from the cause”; no “law” holds sway. We are the ones who have, on our own, made up causes, causal sequences, for-one-another, relativity, compulsion, number, law, freedom, reason, and purpose, and when we fabricate this world of signs inside things as something “in itself,” when we stir it into things, then we’re once again acting as we have always done, namely, mythologically. The “un-free will” is a myth: in real life it’s merely a matter of strong and weak wills.—It is almost always already a symptom of something lacking in a thinker himself when he senses in all “causal connections” and “psychological necessity” some compulsion, necessity, requirement to obey, pressure, and un-freedom. That very feeling is a tell-tale giveaway—the person is betraying himself. And if I have seen things correctly, the “un-freedom of the will” has generally been viewed as a problem from two totally contrasting points of view, but always in a deeply personal way: some people are not willing at any price to let go of their “responsibility,” their belief in themselves, their personal right to their merits (the vain races belong to this group—); others want the reverse: they do not wish to be responsible for or

guilty of anything, and demand, out of an inner self-contempt, that they can shift blame for themselves somewhere else. People in this second group, when they write books, are in the habit nowadays of taking up the cause of criminals; a sort of socialist pity is their most attractive disguise. And in fact, the fatalism of those with weak wills brightens up amazingly when it learns how to present itself as “(T)la religion de la souffrance humaine” [the religion of human suffering]—that’s its “good taste.” 22 People should forgive me, as an old philologist who cannot prevent himself from maliciously setting his finger on corrupt methods of interpretation—but “nature’s conformity to law,” which you physicists talk about so proudly, as if—it exists only thanks to your interpretation and bad “philology”—it is not a matter of fact, a “text, but instead nothing but a naively humanitarian emendation and distortion of meaning, with which you make ample concessions to the democratic instincts of the modern soul! “Equality before the law everywhere—in that respect nature is no different and no better than we are”: a charming ulterior motive, in which once again lies disguised the rabble’s hostility to everything privileged and autocratic, as well as a second and more sophisticated atheism. Ni dieu, ni maître [neither god nor master]—that is how you want it, too, and therefore “Up with natural law!” Isn’t that so? But, as mentioned, that is interpretation, not text, and someone could come along who had an opposite intention and style of interpretation and who would know how to read out of this same nature, with a look at the same phenomena, the tyrannically inconsiderate and inexorable enforcement of power claims—an interpreter who set right before your eyes the unexceptional and unconditional quality in all “will to power,” in such a way that almost every word, even that word “tyranny,” would finally appear unusable or an already weakening metaphor losing its force—as too human—and who nonetheless in the process finished up asserting the same thing about this world as you claim, namely, that it has a “necessary” and “calculable” course, but not because laws rule the world but because there is a total absence of laws, and every power draws its final consequence in every moment. Granted that this also is only an interpretation—and you will be eager enough to raise that objection?—well, so much the better. 23 All psychology so far has remained hung up on moral prejudices and fears. It has not dared to go into the depths. To understand it as the morphology and doctrine of the development of the will to power—the way I understand it—no one in his own thinking has even touched on that, insofar, that is, as one is permitted to recognize in what has been written up to now a symptom of what people so far have kept silent about. The power of moral prejudices has driven deep into the most spiritual, the most apparently cool world, the one with the fewest assumptions, and, as is self-evident, in a way that damages, limits, blinds, and distorts. A true physical psychology has to fight against an unconscious resistance in the heart of the researcher. It has “the heart” against it. Even a

doctrine of the mutual interdependence of the “good” and the “bad” drives creates, as a more sophisticated immorality, distress and aversion in a still powerful and hearty conscience—even more so a doctrine of how all the good drives are derived from the bad ones. But assuming that someone takes the affects of hate, envy, greed, and desire to rule as the affects which determine life, as something that, in the whole balance of life, have to be present fundamentally and essentially, and, as a result, have to be enhanced if life is to be further enhanced—he suffers from an orientation in his judgment as if he were seasick. Nevertheless, even this hypothesis is not nearly the most painful or the strangest in this immense and still almost new realm of dangerous discoveries;—and, in fact, there are a hundred good reasons why everyone should stay away from it, anyone who can! On the other hand, if someone aboard ship wanders here at some point—well, then! Come on! Now’s the time to keep one’s teeth tightly clenched, one’s eyes open, and one’s hand firm on the tiller!—We’re moving away directly over morality, and in the process, as we dare make our way there, we’re overwhelming, perhaps smashing apart, what’s left of our morality,—but what do we matter! Never before has a more profound world of insights revealed itself to venturesome travellers and adventurers: and the psychologist who in this manner “makes a sacrifice”—it is not the sacrificio dell’ intelletto [sacrifice of the intellect], quite the opposite—will for that reason at least be permitted to demand that psychology is recognized again as the mistress of the sciences, with the other sciences there to prepare things in her service. For from now on psychology is once more the route to fundamental problems. NOTES (1) In Greek mythology, the Sphinx was a monster which terrorized Thebes. The peril could only be averted by answering a riddle. Oedipus answered the riddle successfully and was made king of Thebes. [Back to Text] (2) a priori synthetic judgments: a central claim of Kant’s theory of knowledge, these are judgments which do not arise from experience (i.e., they are innate) but which reveal knowledge of experience (like deductively argued mathematically based scientific laws). [Back to Text] (3) Categorical imperative: the key phrase in Kant’s morality, the idea that moral action consists of acting upon a principle which could become a rational moral principle without creating a moral contradiction (“Act so that the maxim [which determines your will] may be capable of becoming a universal law for all rational beings.” Immanuel Kant (1724-1804) was an enormously influential German Enlightenment philosopher. [Back to Text] (4) Baruch de Spinoza (1632-1677), an important and controversial Dutch philosopher; Pallas Athena: the Greek goddess of wisdom. [Back to Text] (5) Nietzsche’s words Wissenschaft and wissenschaftlich, translated as science and scientific, refer to scholarship or academic research methods and activities in general. Their meaning is by no means confined to natural science. [Back to Text] (6) Dionysius (432 to 367 BC), tyrant of Syracuse. [Back to Text] (7) Nietzsche quotes the

Latin: “adventavit asinus/ pulcher et fortissimus.” [Back to Text] (8) The Stoics: a Greek philosophical school (founded in 306 BC) teaching patient endurance and repression of the emotions. [Back to Text] (9) Friedrich Wilhelm Joseph Schelling (1775-1854), a German philosopher. [Back to Text] (10) Nietzsche quotes the Latin, “Quia est in eo virtus dormitiva/ Cujus est natura sensus assoupire.” Moliere (Jean-Baptiste Poquelin, 1622-1673) was a famous French playwright. [Back to Text] (11) Roger Boscovich (1711-1787), a Jesuit philosopher and an important scientific thinker, denied material substance to atoms. His ethnic identity is contested. Nicolaus Copernicus (1473-1543), Polish monk and astronomer, offered a scientific theory for a sun-centred solar system. [Back to Text] (12) Arthur Schopenhauer (1788-1860), an important German philosopher whose work had a significant influence upon Nietzsche. [Back to Text] (13) John Locke (1632-1704), a very influential English philosopher, proposed that the mind at birth was a blank slate, without innate ideas. [Back to Text]

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=== Part 2: The Free Spirit
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=== Friedrich Nietzsche BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL Translated by Ian Johnston, Vancouver Island University, Nanaimo, British Columbia, Canada
Students, teachers, artists, and members of the general public may download and distribute this text without permission and without charge. They may also freely edit the text for their own purposes. All commercial use of this translation, however, is forbidden without the permission of the translator. For comments and questions, please contact Ian Johnston. For a Rich Text Version (Word) of this text, please use the following link: [Beyond Good and Evil \[RTF\]](#) [Table of Contents for Beyond Good and Evil] PART TWO THE FREE SPIRIT 24 O sancta simplicitas [O blessed simplicity]! Human beings live in such a peculiarly simple and counterfeit way! Once a man develops eyes to see this wonder, he cannot check his amazement! How bright and free and light and simple we have made everything around us! How we have learned to give our senses free license for everything superficial, our thinking a divine craving for wanton leaps and erroneous conclusions! How we have learned ways, right from the start, to maintain our ignorance in order to enjoy a hardly conceivable freedom, carelessness, rashness, heartiness, and merriment in life—in order to enjoy life. And only on this now firm granite foundation of ignorance could scientific knowledge up to now rise up, the will to know on the foundation of a much more powerful will, the will not to know, to uncertainty, to what is not true! Not as its opposite, but—as its refinement! For even if language, here as elsewhere, does not cast off its clumsiness and continues to speak about opposites where there are only degrees and many subtleties of gradation, and similarly if

inveterate Tartufferie [hypocrisy] in morality, which nowadays belongs to our invincible “flesh and blood,” turns the words even of us knowledgeable people around in our mouths, here and there we understand that and laugh about how it’s precisely the best scientific knowledge that most wants to hold us in this simplified, completely artificial, appropriately created, and appropriately falsified world, and about how, willingly or unwillingly, it loves error, because, as something alive—it loves life! 25 After such a cheerful start, I’d like you to not to miss hearing a serious word: it’s directed at the most serious people. Be careful, you philosophers and friends, of knowledge—protect yourself from martyrdom! From suffering “for the sake of the truth”! Even from defending yourselves! That corrupts all the innocence and refined neutrality in your consciences. It makes you stubborn against objections and red rags; it dulls your minds, turns you into an animal and a brute, when, in the struggle with danger, slander, suspicion, expulsion, and even dirtier consequences of hostility, you finally have to play out your role as the defenders of truth on earth, as though “the truth” were such a harmless and clumsy character as to require defenders! And as for you, you knights with the most sorrowful countenances, my gentlemen loafers and spiritual cobweb spinners! Ultimately you yourselves know well enough that it really doesn’t matter if you are the ones who are proved right. You also know that up to now no philosopher has been proved right and that a more praiseworthy truthfulness could lie in every small question mark which you set after your favourite words and cherished doctrines (and occasionally after yourselves), than in all the ceremonial gestures and trump cards before prosecutors and courts of justice! Better to stand aside! Run off to some secluded place! And retain your masks and your subtlety, so that people confuse you with someone else—or fear you a little! And for my sake don’t forget the garden, the garden with the golden trellis! And have people around you who are like a garden—or like music over water in the evening, when the day is already becoming a memory. Choose good solitude, the free, high-spirited, easy solitude, which also gives you a right to remain, in some sense or other, still good yourselves! How poisonous, how crafty, how bad every long war makes us, when it does not let us fight with open force! How personal a long fear makes us, a long attention on our enemies, on potential enemies! These social outcasts, these men long persecuted and wickedly hunted down—as well as the compulsory recluses, the Spinozas or Giordano Brunos—in the end always become, even under the most spiritual masquerade and perhaps without realizing it themselves, sophisticated avengers and makers of poisons (just dig into the foundation of Spinoza’s ethics and theology)—to say nothing of the foolishness of moral indignation, which in a philosopher is the unmistakable sign that his philosophical humour has run away from him.(1) The martyrdom of a philosopher, his “sacrifice for the truth,” brings forcefully to light how much of

the agitator and actor he contains within himself. And if people have looked at him with only an artistic curiosity up to this point, then, in the case of several philosophers, we can naturally understand the dangerous wish to see him also in his degeneration (degenerated into a “martyr,” into a noisy troublemaker on the stage and in tribunals). But with such a wish, people must be clear about what they are going to see in every case—only a satyr play, only a farcical epilogue, only continuing proof that the long, real tragedy is over, assuming that every philosophy in its origin was a long tragedy. 26 Every special human being strives instinctively for his own castle and secrecy, where he is saved from the crowd, the many, the majority, where he can forget the ordinary “people” who are the rule [die Regel “Mensch”], for he is an exception to them—but for the single case where he is pushed by an even stronger instinct straight against this rule, as a person who seeks knowledge in a great and exceptional sense. Anyone who, in his intercourse with human beings, does not, at one time or another, shimmer with all the colours of distress—green and gray with disgust, surfeit, sympathy, gloom, and loneliness—is certainly not a man of higher taste. But provided he does not take all this weight and lack of enthusiasm freely upon himself, always keeps away from it, and stays, as mentioned, hidden, quiet, and proud in his castle, well, one thing is certain: he was not made for, not destined for, knowledge. For if he were, he would one day have to say to himself, “The devil take my good taste! The rule is more interesting than the exception—than I am, the exception!”—and he would make his way down and, above all, “inside.” The study of the average man—long, serious, and requiring much disguise, self-control, familiarity, bad company—all company is bad company except with one’s peers—that constitutes a necessary part of the life story of every philosopher, perhaps the most unpleasant, foul-smelling part, the richest in disappointments. But if he’s lucky, as is appropriate for a fortunate child of knowledge, he encounters real short cuts and people who make his task easier—I’m referring to the so-called cynics, those who, as such, simply recognize the animal, the meanness, the “rule” in themselves and, in the process, still possess that degree of spirituality and urge to have to talk about themselves and people like them before witnesses;—now and then they even wallow in books, as if in their very own dung. Cynicism is the single form in which common souls touch upon what honesty is, and the higher man should open his ears to every cruder and more refined cynicism and think himself lucky every time a shameless clown or a scientific satyr announces himself directly in front of him. There are even cases where enchantment gets mixed into the disgust: for example, in those places where, by some vagary of nature, genius is bound up with such an indiscreet billy-goat and ape—as in the Abbé Galiani, the most profound, sharp-sighted, and perhaps also the foulest man of his century—he was much deeper than Voltaire and consequently a good deal quieter.(2) More frequently, as I have

intimated, it happens that the scientific head is set on an ape's body, a refined and exceptional understanding in a common soul—among doctors and moral physiologists, in particular, that's not an uncommon occurrence. And wherever anyone speaks without bitterness and quite innocently of man as a belly with two different needs and a head with one, wherever someone constantly sees, looks for, and wants to see only hunger, sexual desire, and vanity, as if these were the real and only motivating forces in human actions, in short, wherever people speak “badly” of human beings—not even in a nasty way—there the lover of knowledge should pay fine and diligent attention; he should, in general, direct his ears to wherever people talk without indignation. For the indignant man and whoever is always using his own teeth to tear himself apart or lacerate himself (or, as a substitute for that, the world, or God, or society) may indeed, speaking morally, stand higher than the laughing and self-satisfied satyr, but in every other sense he is the more ordinary, the more trivial, the more un instructive case. And no one lies as much as the indignant man. 27 It is difficult to be understood, particularly when one thinks and lives gangasrotogati [like the flow of the river Ganges], among nothing but people who think and live differently, namely kurmagati [like the movements of a tortoise] or, in the best cases “following the gait of frogs” mandeikagati—am I simply doing everything to make myself difficult to understand?—and people should appreciate from their hearts the good will in some subtlety of interpretation. But so far as “good friends” are concerned, those who are always too lackadaisical and believe they have a particular right as friends to a life of comfort, one does well to start by giving them a recreation room and playground of misunderstanding:—so one still has to laugh—or else to get rid of them altogether, these good friends—and to laugh then, as well! 28 The most difficult thing about translating one language into another is the tempo of its style, which is rooted in the character of the race—speaking more physiologically, in the average tempo of its “metabolism.” There are honestly intended translations that, as involuntarily coarse versions of the original, are almost misrepresentations, simply because its brave and cheerful tempo, which springs over and neutralizes everything dangerous in things and words, could not be translated. A German is almost incapable of presto [quick tempo] in his language and thus, as we can reasonably infer, is also incapable of many of the most delightful and most daring nuances of free and free-spirited thinking. Just as the buffo [comic actor or singer] and satyr are foreign to him, in body and conscience, so Aristophanes and Petronius are untranslatable for him. Everything solemn, slow moving, ceremonially massive, all lengthy and boring varieties in style are developed among the Germans in a lavish diversity. You must forgive me for the fact that even Goethe's prose, with its mixture of stiffness and daintiness, is no exception, as a mirror image of the “good old time” to which it belongs, and as an

expression of German taste in an age when there still was a “German taste,” a rococo taste in *moribus et artibus* [in customs and the arts].(3) Lessing is an exception, thanks to his play-actor’s nature, which understood a great deal and knew how to do many things. He was not the translator of Bayle for nothing and was happy to take refuge in Diderot’s or Voltaire’s company—and even happier among the Roman writers of comic drama. In tempo, too, Lessing loved free-spiritedness, the flight from Germany. But how could the German language—even in the prose of a Lessing—imitate the tempo of Machiavelli, who in his *Prince* allows one to breathe the fine dry air of Florence and cannot help presenting the most serious affairs in a boisterous *allegro* [very quick tempo], perhaps not without a malicious artistic feeling about what a contrast he is risking—long, difficult, hard, dangerous ideas, a galloping tempo, and the very best, most mischievous of moods.(4) Finally, who could even venture a German translation of Petronius, who was the master of the *presto*—more so than any great musician so far—in invention, ideas, and words. Ultimately what is so important about all the swamps of the sick, nasty world, even the “ancient world,” when someone like him has feet of wind, drive, and breath, the liberating scorn of a wind which makes everything healthy, as he makes everything run! And so far as Aristophanes is concerned, that transfiguring, complementary spirit for whose sake we excuse all Hellenism for having existed, provided that we have understood in all profundity everything that needs to be forgiven and transfigured there;—I don’t know what makes me dream about Plato’s secrecy and sphinx-like nature more than that *petit fait* [small fact], which fortunately has been preserved, that under the pillow on his deathbed people found no “Bible,” nothing Egyptian, Pythagorean, or Platonic—but something by Aristophanes. How could even a Plato have endured life—a Greek life, to which he said no—without an Aristophanes! 29 It’s the business of very few people to be independent:—that is a right of the strong. And whoever attempts it—even with the best right to it, but without being compelled to—shows by that action that he is probably not only strong but exuberantly daring. He is entering a labyrinth; he is increasing a thousand-fold the dangers which life already brings with it, not the least of which is the fact that no one’s eyes see how and where he goes astray, gets isolated, and is torn to pieces by some cavern-dwelling Minotaur of conscience. Suppose such a person comes to a bad end, that happens so far away from men’s understanding that they feel nothing and have no sympathy:—and he cannot go back any more! He cannot even go back to human pity!(5)— 30 Our loftiest insights must—and should!—ring out like foolishness, under certain circumstances like crimes, when in some forbidden way they come to the ears of those for whom they are not suitable and who are not predestined for them. The exoteric and the esoteric views, as people earlier differentiated them among philosophers, with Indians as with Greeks, Persians, and Muslims, in short,

wherever people believed in a hierarchy of rank and not in equality and equal rights—this differentiation does not arise so much from the fact that the exoteric philosopher stands outside and looks, assesses, measures, and judges from the outside, not from the inside: the more essential point is that the exoteric philosopher sees the matter looking up from underneath, but the esoteric one sees it looking down from above! There are heights of the soul viewed from which even tragedy ceases to work its tragic effect, and if we gathered all the sorrow of the world into one sorrow, who could dare to decide if a glance at it would necessarily seduce and compel us to pity and thus to a doubling of that sorrow? . . . What serves the higher kind of man as nourishment or refreshment must be almost poison to a very different and lower kind of man. The virtues of the common man would perhaps amount to vices and weaknesses in a philosopher; it could be possible that a higher kind of person, if he is degenerating and nearing his end, only then acquires characteristics for whose sake people in the lower world, into which he has sunk, would find it necessary to honour him as a saint from now on. There are books which have an opposite value for the soul and for health, depending on whether the lower soul, the lower vitality, or the higher and more powerful soul makes use of them: with the first group, the books are dangerous, shattering, and disintegrating; with the second group, they are a herald's summons, which provokes the bravest to show their courage. Books for the whole world always smell foul: the stink of small people clings to them. Where the folk eat and drink, even where they worship, the place usually smells. One should not go into churches if one wants to breathe clean air. 31 In their young years, people worship and despise still without that art of subtlety that constitutes the greatest gain in life. And it's reasonable enough that they must atone, with some difficulty, for having bombarded men and things in such a way with Yes and No. Everything is arranged so that the worst of all tastes, the taste for the absolute, will be terribly parodied and misused until people learn to put some art into their feelings and even prefer risking an attempt with artificiality, as the real artists of life do. The anger and reverence typical of the young do not seem to ease up until they have sufficiently distorted people and things so that they can vent themselves on them. —Youth is in itself already something fraudulent and deceptive. Later, when the young soul, tortured by nothing but disappointments, finally turns back against itself suspiciously, still hot and wild, even in its suspicion and pangs of conscience, how it rages against itself from this point on, how it tears itself apart impatiently, how it takes revenge for its lengthy self-deception, as if it had been a voluntary blindness! In this transition people punish themselves through their mistrust of their own feeling; they torment their enthusiasm with doubt; indeed, they even feel good conscience as a danger, as a veiling of the self, so to speak, an exhaustion of their finer honesty. Above all, people take sides, on principle the

side against “the young.”—A decade later, they understand that all this was also still—youth! 32 Throughout the lengthiest period of human history—we call it the prehistoric age—the value or the lack of value in an action was derived from its consequences. Thus, the action in itself was considered as insignificant as its origin, but, in somewhat the same way as even today in China an honour or disgrace reaches back from the child to the parents, so then it was the backward working power of success or failure which taught people to consider an action good or bad. Let’s call this period the pre-moralistic period of humanity: the imperative “Know thyself!” was then still unknown. In the last ten millennia, by contrast, people in a few large regions of the earth have come, step by step, to the point where they allow the value of an action to be determined, no longer by its consequences, but by its origin. On the whole, this was a great event, a considerable improvement in vision and standards, the unconscious influence of the ruling power of aristocratic values and of faith in “origins,” the sign of a period which one can designate moralistic in a narrower sense: with it the first attempt at self-knowledge was undertaken. Instead of the consequences, the origin: what a reversal of perspective! And this reversal was surely attained only after lengthy battles and fluctuations! Of course, in the process a disastrous new superstition, a peculiar narrowing of interpretation, gained control. People interpreted the origin of an action in the most particular sense as an origin from an intention. They became unanimous in believing that the value of an action lay in the value of its intention. The intention as the entire origin and prehistory of an action: in accordance with this bias people on earth have, almost up to the most recent times, given moral approval, criticized, judged, and also practised philosophy. But today shouldn’t we have reached the point where we must once again make up our minds about a reversal and fundamental shift in values, thanks to a renewed self-reflection and profundity in human beings? Are we not standing on the threshold of a period which we might at first designate negatively as outside morality: today, when the suspicion stirs, at least among us immoralists, that the decisive value of an action may lie precisely in what is unintentional in it and that all its intentionality, everything in it that we can see, know, and “are conscious of,” still belongs to its surface layer and skin,—which, like every skin, indicates something but conceals even more? In short, we believe that the intention is only a sign and a symptom, something still needing interpretation, and furthermore a sign that carries too many meanings and, thus, by itself alone means almost nothing. We think that morality, in the earlier sense, that is, a morality based on intentions, has been a prejudice, something rash and perhaps provisional, something along the lines of astrology and alchemy, but in any case something that must be overcome. The overpowering of morality, in a certain sense even the self-conquering of morality: let that be the name for the long secret work which remained reserved for the finest and most honest, and

also the most malicious consciences nowadays, as living touchstones of the soul. 33 That is the only way: we must mercilessly put in question and bring before the court feelings of devotion, sacrificing for one's neighbour, the entire morality of self-renunciation, and, in exactly the same way, the aesthetic of "disinterested contemplation," according to which the emasculation of art seductively attempts these days to create a good conscience for itself. There is much too much magic and sweetness in those feelings "for others," "not for myself," for us not to find it necessary to grow doubly mistrustful here and to ask, "Are these not perhaps—seductions?"—The fact that those feelings please the person who has them and the one who enjoys their fruits, as well as the one who merely looks on—this still provides no argument for them. On the contrary, that demands immediate caution. So let's be cautious! 34 No matter what philosophical standpoint people may adopt nowadays, from every point of view the falsity of the world in which we think we live is the most certain and firmest thing our eyes are still capable of apprehending:—for that we find reason after reason, something that might well to entice us into conjectures about a deceitful principle in the "essence of things." But anyone who makes our very thinking, that is, "the intellect," responsible for the falsity of the world—an honourable solution which every conscious or unconscious advocatus dei [pleader for god] uses:— whoever takes this world, together with space, time, form, and movement as a false inference, such a person would at least have good ground finally to learn to be distrustful of all thinking itself. Would it not be the case that thinking has played the greatest of all tricks on us up to this point? And what guarantee would there be that thinking would not continue to do what it has always done? In all seriousness: the innocence of thinkers has something touching, something inspiring reverence, which permits them even today still to present themselves before consciousness with the request that it give them honest answers: for example, to the question whether it is "real," and why it really keeps itself so resolutely separate from the outer world, and similar sorts of questions. The belief in "immediate certainties" is amoral naïveté which brings honour to us philosophers—but for once we should not be "merely moral" men! Setting aside morality, this belief is a stupidity that brings us little honour! It may be the case that in bourgeois life the constant willingness to suspect is considered a sign of a "bad character" and thus belongs among those things considered unwise. Here among us, beyond the bourgeois world and its affirmations and denials—what is there to stop us from being unwise and saying that the philosopher has an absolute right to a "bad character," as the being who up to this point on earth has always been fooled the best—today he has the duty to be suspicious, to glance around maliciously from every depth of distrust. Forgive me the joke of this gloomy grimace and way of expressing myself. For a long time ago I myself learned to think differently and to make different evaluations about deceiving and being deceived, and I keep

ready at least a couple of digs in the ribs for the blind anger with which philosophers themselves resist being deceived. Why not? It is nothing more than a moral prejudice that truth is worth more than appearance. That claim is even the most poorly demonstrated assumption there is in the world. People should at least concede this much: there would be no life at all if not on the basis of appearances and assessments from perspectives. And if people, with the virtuous enthusiasm and clumsiness of some philosophers, wanted to do away entirely with the “apparent world,” assuming, of course, you could do that, well then at least nothing would remain any more of your “truth” either! In fact, what compels us generally to the assumption that there is an essential opposition between “true” and “false”? Is it not enough to assume degrees of appearance and, as it were, lighter and darker shadows and tones for the way things appear—different *valeurs* [values], to use the language of painters? Why could the world about which we have some concern—not be a fiction? And if someone then asks “But doesn’t an author belong to a fiction?” could we not bluntly answer: Why? Doesn’t this “belong to” perhaps belong to the fiction? Is it then forbidden to be a little ironic about the subject as well as about the predicate and the object? Is the philosopher not permitted to rise above a faith in grammar? All due respect to governesses, but might it not be time for philosophy to renounce faith in governesses?— 35 O Voltaire! O humanity! O nonsense! There’s something about the “truth,” about the search for truth. And when someone goes after it in far too human a way—“il ne cherche le vrai que pour faire le bien” [he seeks the truth only to do good]—I’ll wager he comes up with nothing! 36 If we assume that nothing is “given” as real other than our world of desires and passions and that we cannot access from above or below any “reality” other than the direct reality of our drives—for thinking is only a relationship of these drives to each other—are we not allowed to make the attempt to ask the question whether this given is not sufficient also for understanding, on the basis of things like it, the so-called mechanical (or “material”) world. I don’t mean to understand it as an illusion, an “appearance,” an “idea” (in the sense of Berkeley and Schopenhauer), but as having the same degree of reality as our emotions themselves have—as a more primitive form of the world of emotions, in which everything is still combined in a powerful unity, which then branches off and develops in the organic process (also, as is reasonable, gets softer and weaker—), as a form of instinctual life in which the collective organic functions, along with self-regulation, assimilation, nourishment, excretion, and metabolism, are still synthetically bound up with one another—as an early form of life?(6) In the end making this attempt is not only permitted but is also demanded by the conscience of the method. Not to assume various forms of causality as long as the attempt to manage with a single one has not been pushed to its furthest limit (—all the way to nonsense, if I may say so): that is a moral of the method which people

nowadays may not evade;—as a mathematician would say, it is a consequence “of its definition.” In the end the question is whether we really acknowledge the will as something efficient, whether we believe in the causal properties of the will. If we do—and basically our faith in this is simply our faith in causality itself—then we must make the attempt to set up hypothetically the causality of the will as the single causality. Of course, “will” can work only on “will”—and not on “stuff” (not, for example, on “nerves”—). Briefly put, we must venture the hypothesis whether in general, wherever we recognize “effects,” will is not working on will—and whether every mechanical event, to the extent that a force is active in it, is not force of will, an effect of the will.—Suppose finally that we were to succeed in explaining our entire instinctual life as a development and branching off of a single fundamental form of the will—that is, of the will to power, as my proposition asserts—and suppose we could trace back all organic functions to this will to power and also locate in it the solution to the problem of reproduction and nourishment—that is one problem—then in so doing we would have earned the right to designate all efficient force unambiguously as will to power. Seen from inside, the world defined and described according to its “intelligible character” would be simply “will to power” and nothing else.— 37 “What’s that? Doesn’t that mean in popular language that God is disproved, but the devil is not—?” On the contrary, on the contrary, my friends! And in the devil’s name, who is forcing you to speak such common language? 38 What happened only very recently, in all the brightness of modern times, with the French Revolution, that ghastly and, considered closely, superfluous farce, which, however, noble and rapturous observers from all Europe have been interpreting from a distance for so long and so passionately according to their own outrage and enthusiasm that the text disappeared under the interpretation, in the same way a noble posterity could once again misunderstand all the past and only by doing that perhaps make looking at that past tolerable.—Or rather, hasn’t this already happened? Have we ourselves not been—this “noble posterity”? And, to the extent that we understand this point, is not this the very moment when—it is over? 39 No one will readily consider a doctrine true simply because it makes us happy or virtuous, except perhaps the gentle “idealists,” who go into raptures about the good, the true, and the beautiful and allow all sorts of colourful, clumsy, and good-natured desirable things to swim around in confusion in their pond. Happiness and virtue are no arguments. But people, even judicious spirits, do like to forget that causing unhappiness and evil are by the same token no counterarguments. Something could well be true, although it is at the same time harmful and dangerous to the highest degree. In fact, it could even be part of the fundamental nature of existence that people are destroyed when they fully understand it—so that the strength of a spirit might be measured by how much it could still endure of the “truth,” or stated more clearly, by the

degree it would have to have the truth diluted, masked, sweetened, muffled, and falsified. But there is no doubt about the fact that evil and unhappy people are more favoured and have a greater probability of success in discovering certain parts of the truth, to say nothing of the evil people who are happy—a species that moralists are silent about. Perhaps toughness and cunning provide more favourable conditions for the development of the strong, independent spirit and the philosopher than that gentle, refined, conciliatory good nature and that art of taking things lightly which people value in a scholar, and value rightly. If we assume, first of all, that the notion of a “philosopher” is not restricted to the philosopher who writes books—or even puts his own philosophy into books! — A final characteristic in the picture of the free-spirited philosopher is provided by Stendhal. Because of German taste I don’t wish to overlook emphasizing this trait—for it goes against German taste. This last great psychologist states the following: “To be a good philosopher it is necessary to be dry, clear, without illusions. A banker who has made a fortune has one part of the character required to make discoveries in philosophy, that is to say, to see clearly into what is.”(7) 40 Everything profound loves the mask. The most profound things of all even have a hatred for image and comparison. Shouldn’t the right disguise in which the shame of a god walks around be something exactly opposite? A questionable question: it would be strange if some mystic or other had not already ventured something like that on his own. There are processes of such a delicate sort that people do well to bury them in something crude and make them unrecognizable. There are actions of love and of extravagant generosity, after which there is nothing more advisable than to grab a stick and give an eyewitness a good thrashing:—in so doing we cloud his memory. Some people know how to befuddle or batter their own memories in order at least to take revenge on this single witness:—shame is resourceful. It is not the worst things that make people feel the worst shame. Behind a mask there is not only malice—there is so much goodness in cunning. I could imagine that a person who had something valuable and vulnerable to preserve might roll through life as coarse and round as an old green wine barrel with strong hoops. The delicacy of his shame wants it that way. For a person whose shame is profound encounters even his fate and delicate decisions on pathways which few people ever reach and of whose existence those closest to him and his most intimate associates are not permitted to know. His mortal danger hides itself from their eyes, just as his confidence in life does, once he regains it. A person who is concealed in this way, who from instinct uses speaking for silence and keeping quiet and who is tireless in avoiding communication, wants and demands that, instead of him, a mask of him wanders around in the hearts and heads of his friends. And suppose he does not want that mask: one day his eyes will open to the fact that nonetheless there is a mask of him there—and that that’s a good thing. Every profound spirit needs a mask;

even more, around every profound spirit a mask is continuously growing, thanks to the constantly false, that is, shallow interpretation of every word, every step, every sign of life he gives.— 41 A person has to test himself to see that he is meant for independence and command—and he must do this at the right time. He should not evade his tests, although they are perhaps the most dangerous game he can play, tests which in the end are made only with ourselves as witnesses and with no other judges. Not to get stuck on a single person:—not even on the someone one loves the most. Every person is a prison—a cranny as well. And not to remain stuck on one's fatherland:—not even if it is enduring the greatest suffering and in the greatest need of assistance—it is less difficult to disentangle one's heart from a victorious fatherland. Not to be stuck on pity, even in the case of higher men whose rare torment and helplessness some fortuitous circumstance has allowed us to see. Not to be stuck on a science, not even if it tempts us with the most precious discoveries apparently reserved explicitly for us. Not to get stuck on one's own detachment, on that sensual distancing and strangeness of a bird constantly soaring further up into the heights in order always to see more beneath it:—the danger of the man in flight. Not to get stuck on our own virtues and let our totality become a sacrifice to some particular detail in us, for example, our "hospitality," the danger of dangers for lofty and rich souls, who spread themselves around lavishly, almost indifferently, and push the virtue of liberality into a vice. One must know how to preserve oneself: the sternest test of independence. 42 A new sort of philosopher is emerging: I venture to baptize them with a name that is not without danger. As I figure them out—to the extent that they let themselves be figured out, for it belongs to their type to want to remain something of an enigma—these philosophers of the future may have a right, perhaps also a wrong, to be described as attempters. This name itself is finally merely an attempt and, if you will, a temptation.(8) 43 Are they new friends of the "truth," these emerging philosophers? That seems plausible enough: for all philosophers up to this point have loved their truths. But they certainly will not be dogmatists. It must go against their pride as well as their taste if their truth is still supposed to be some truth for everyman: and that has been the secret wish and deeper meaning of all dogmatic efforts up to now. "My judgment is my judgment: someone else has no casual right to it"—that's what such a philosopher of the future will perhaps say. One must rid oneself of the bad taste of wanting to agree with many. "Good" is no longer good when one's neighbour utters it. And how could there even be a "common good"! That expression contradicts itself: whatever can be common always has only little value. In the end things must stand as they stand and have always stood: great things remain for the great, the abysses for the profound, sensitivity and shudders for the refined, and, to sum up all this in brief, everything rare for the rare.— 44 After all this do I still need expressly to state that they will also be free, very free

spirits, these philosophers of the future—although it's also certain that they will not be merely free spirits but something more, higher, greater, and fundamentally different that does not wish to be misunderstood and confused with something else? But as I say this, I feel a duty almost as much to them as to us who are their heralds and precursors, we free spirits!—the duty to blow away an old stupid prejudice and misunderstanding about us both, something which for too long has made the idea “free spirit” as impenetrable as fog. In all the countries of Europe and in America as well there is now something which drives people to misuse this name, a very narrow, confined, chained-up type of spirit which wants something rather like the opposite of what lies in our intentions and instincts—to say nothing of the fact that, so far as those emerging new philosophers are concerned, such spirits definitely must be closed windows and bolted doors. To put the matter briefly and seriously, these falsely named “free spirits” belong with the levellers, as eloquent and prolific writing slaves of democratic taste and its “modern ideas”: collectively people without solitude, without their own solitude, coarse brave lads whose courage or respectable decency should not be denied. But they are simply unfree and ridiculously superficial, above all with their basic tendency to see in the forms of old societies up to now the cause for almost all human misery and failure, a process which turns the truth happily on its head! What they would like to strive for with all their powers is the universal, green, pasture-happiness of the herd, with security, absence of danger, comfort, an easing of life for everyone. The two songs and doctrines they sing most frequently are called “equality of rights” and “pity for all things that suffer”—and they assume that suffering itself is something we must do away with. We who are their opposites, we who have opened our eyes and consciences for the question of where and how up to now the plant “man” has grown most powerfully to the heights, we think that this has happened every time under the opposite conditions, that for this to happen the danger of his situation first had to grow enormously, his power of invention and pretence (his “spirit”—) had to develop under lengthy pressure and compulsion into something refined and audacious, his will for living had to intensify into an unconditional will to power:—we think that hardness, violence, slavery, danger in the alley and the heart, seclusion, stoicism, the art of the tempter, and devilry of all kinds, that everything evil, fearful, tyrannical, predatory, and snake-like in human beings serves well for the ennobling of the species “man,” as much as its opposite does:—in fact, when we say only this much we have not said enough, and we find ourselves at any rate with our speaking and silence at a point at the other end of all modern ideology and things desired by the herd, perhaps as their exact opposites? Is it any wonder that we “free spirits” are not exactly the most communicative spirits? That we do not want to give away every detail of what a spirit can free itself from and where it will then perhaps be driven? And as far as

the meaning of the dangerous formula “beyond good and evil” is concerned, with which we at least protect ourselves from being confused with others, we are something different from “libres-penseurs,” “liberi pensatori,” “freidenker,” [free thinkers] and whatever else all these good advocates of “modern ideas” love to call themselves. Having been at home or at least a guest in many countries of the spirit, having slipped away again and again from the musty comfortable corners into which preference and prejudice, youth, descent, contingencies of men and books, or even exhaustion from wandering around seem to have banished us, full of malice against the enticement of dependency, which lies hidden in honours, or money, or offices, or sensuous enthusiasm, thankful even for distress and the frequent vicissitudes of sickness, because they always freed us from some rule or other and its “prejudice,” thankful to god, devil, sheep, and worm in us, curious to a fault, researchers all the way to cruelty, with fingers spontaneously working for the unimaginable, with teeth and stomachs for the most indigestible things, ready for any job which demands astuteness and keen senses, ready for any exploit, thanks to an excess of “free will,” with front-souls and back-souls whose final intentions no one can easily see, with foregrounds and backgrounds that no foot may move through to the end, hidden under cloaks of light, conquerors, whether we appear like heirs and spendthrifts, stewards and collectors from dawn to dusk, miserly with our wealth and our crammed drawers, economical in learning and forgetting, resourceful in coming up with schemes, sometimes proud of tables of categories, sometimes pedants, sometimes night owls at work, even in broad daylight, in fact, when necessary, even scarecrows—and nowadays that’s necessary: that is, to the extent that we are born the sworn jealous friends of solitude, of our own most profound, most midnight, and most noontime solitude:—we are that kind of men, we free spirits! And perhaps you also are something like that, you who are coming, you new philosophers? NOTES (1) Giordano Bruno (1548-1600), an Italian philosopher who defended the theories of Copernicus (among other things), and was burned at the stake for heresy. Baruch de Spinoza (1632-1677), a Dutch philosopher, was constantly attacked for his heretical views. [Back to Text] (2) Ferdinand Galiani (1728-1787), an Italian philosopher. Voltaire: pen name of Francois Marie Arouet (1694-1778), a very important and famous French Enlightenment writer. [Back to Text] (3) Aristophanes (456-386 BC), foremost writer of Old Comedy in classical Athens; Petronius (27-66 AD), a famous Roman satirist. Johann Wolfgang von Goethe (1749-1832), Germany’s greatest man of letters and literary artist. [Back to Text] (4) Gotthold Ephraim Lessing (1729-1781), an important German dramatist. Bayle: Marie Henri Bayle (1783-1842), a well-known French novelist who wrote under the pen name Stendhal. Denis Diderot (1713-1784), French philosopher and writer, a major figure in the Enlightenment. Niccolo Machiavelli (1469-1527), Italian diplomat,

dramatist, and political philosopher. [Back to Text] (5) Minotaur: in Greek mythology a monster, part man, part bull, living in the middle of the Labyrinth in Cnossus in Crete. [Back to Text] (6) George Berkeley (1685-1753), Irish bishop and philosopher. [Back to Text] (7) Stendhal: the pen name of the French novelist Marie Henri Bayle (1783-1842). Nietzsche quotes from the French: “pour être bon philosophe, il faut être sec, clair, sans illusion. Un banquier, qui a fait fortune, a une partie du caractère requis pour faire des découvertes en philosophie, c’est-à-dire pour voir clair dans ce qui est.” [Back to Text] (8) Nietzsche’s word Versuchen means both attempter and experimenter. The very similar word Versuchung means temptation. [Back to Text]

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 === Part 3: The Religious Mood
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==== Friedrich Nietzsche BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL Translated by Ian Johnston, Vancouver Island University, Nanaimo, British Columbia, Canada
 Students, teachers, artists, and members of the general public may download and distribute this text without permission and without charge. They may also freely edit the text for their own purposes. All commercial use of this translation, however, is forbidden without the permission of the translator. For comments and questions, please contact Ian Johnston. For a Rich Text Version (Word) of this text, please use the following link: Beyond Good and Evil [RTF] [Table of Contents for Beyond Good and Evil] PART THREE THE RELIGIOUS NATURE(1) 45 The human soul and its boundaries, the range of human inner experiences so far attained, the heights, depths, and extent of these experiences, the whole history of the soul up to this point and its still undrained possibilities: for a born psychologist and lover of the “great hunt” that is the predestined hunting ground. But how often must such a man say to himself in despair: “I’m just one man! Alas, only one man! And this is a huge wood, a primordial forest!” And so he wishes he could have few hundred helpers in the hunt and finely trained tracking dogs which he could drive into the history of the human soul in order to corner his wild animal there. A vain hope. He experiences over and over again, thoroughly and bitterly, how difficult it is to find helpers and hounds for all things which appeal to his curiosity. The problem he has in sending scholars out into new and dangerous hunting grounds, where courage, intelligence, and refinement are necessary in every sense, is that that’s precisely the place where scholars are no longer useful, where the “great hunt” but also the great danger begins:—right there they lose their keen eyes and noses for hunting. In order to ascertain and to establish, for example, what sort of history the problem of knowledge and conscience in the soul of the homines religiosi [religious men] has had up to now, the individual would himself perhaps have to be as profound, as wounded, and as monstrous as the intellectual conscience of Pascal

was:—and then it would still be necessary to have that expansive heaven of bright, malicious spirituality capable of surveying from above this teeming mass of dangerous and painful experiences, of ordering it, and of forcing it into formulas.(2) But who would perform this service for me? And who would have time to wait for such servants?—It's clear they arise too rarely. In all ages they are so unlikely! In the end, a person must do everything himself in order to know a few things himself: that means that one has much to do!—But at all events a curiosity of the sort I have remains the most pleasant of all vices.—Forgive me. I wanted to say this: the love of the truth has its reward in heaven and even on earth.— 46 The faith demanded and not rarely attained by early Christianity in the midst of a sceptical and southern world of free spirits that had behind and within it a centuries-long battle among philosophical schools, in addition to the education in tolerance provided by the imperium romanum [Roman empire]—this faith is not that naive and gruff faith of the subordinate, something like the faith with which a Luther or a Cromwell or some other northern barbarian of the spirit hung onto his god and his Christianity.(3) That earlier faith is much more similar to Pascal's belief, which looks, in a terrifying way, something like a constant suicide of reason, a tenacious, long-lived, worm-like reason, which cannot be killed once and for all with a single blow. From the start Christian faith has been sacrifice: a sacrifice of all freedom, all pride, all self-confidence about the spirit, and at the same time slavery and self-mockery, self-mutilation. There is cruelty and a religious Phoenicianism in this faith, which one expects in a crumbling, multilayered, and very spoilt conscience: its assumption is that the subjection of the spirit is indescribably painful, that the entire past and the habits of such a spirit resist the absurdissimum [the most extreme absurdity], which is how this "faith" confronts it. Modern people, with their insensitivity to all Christian nomenclature, do not sense any more the ghastly superlative that lay in the paradox of the formula "God on the cross" for the taste of classical antiquity. To this point there has never yet been anywhere such an audacious reversal—anything as dreadful, questioning, and questionable, as this formula: it promised an inversion of all ancient values.—It is the Orient, the deep Orient, it is the Oriental slave who in this way took his revenge on Rome and its noble and frivolous tolerance, on the Roman "catholicity" of faith:—and what always enraged the slaves about their masters and against their masters was not their faith but their freedom from faith, that half-stoic, smiling lack of concern about the seriousness of belief. "Enlightenment" fills people with rage, for the slave wants something absolute; he understands only the tyrannical, even in morality; he loves as he hates, without subtlety, to the depths, to the point of pain, to the point of sickness. His many hidden sufferings grow incensed against the noble taste that seems to deny suffering. The scepticism about suffering, basically only an attitude of aristocratic morality, was also not the most insignificant factor in

the origin of the last great slave revolt, which began with the French Revolution. 47 Up to this point, wherever religious neurosis has appeared on earth, we find it tied up with three dangerous dietary rules: isolation, fasting, and sexual abstinence—although it would be impossible to determine with certainty what in this may be cause and what may be effect and whether there is, in fact, a relationship between cause and effect here. This final doubt is justified by the fact that among the most regular symptoms of the religious neurosis, both with savage and docile peoples, belongs also the most sudden and most dissolute sensuality which then, just as suddenly, turns into spasms of repentance and a denial of the world and the will. We could interpret both perhaps as masked epilepsy? But nowhere should people resist interpretations more than here. About no type up to this point has such a glut of absurdity and superstition proliferated. No other type so far seems to have interested human beings, even philosophers, more than this one. It's high time to become a little cool on this issue, to learn caution, or better yet, to look away, to go away. Even in the background of the most recent philosophy, the work of Schopenhauer, there stands, almost as the essential problem, this dreadful question mark of the religious crisis and awakening. How is denial of the will possible? How is the saint possible?— This seems, in fact, to have been the question which prompted Schopenhauer to become a philosopher and to begin. Hence, it was a result really worthy of Schopenhauer that his most convinced follower (perhaps also his last, where Germany is concerned), namely, Richard Wagner, brought his own life's work to an end at this very point and finally led out onto the stage the living physical embodiment of that fearful and eternal type as Kundry, type vécu [a real-life type], at the very time when the psychiatrists of almost all the countries of Europe had an opportunity to study it up close, in every place where the religious neurosis—or as I call it, “the religious nature”—had its most recent epidemic outbreak and paraded around as the “Salvation Army.”(4) But if we ask ourselves what has really been so wildly interesting in the whole phenomenon of the saint for people of all types and ages, even for philosophers, then undoubtedly it is the appearance of a miracle associated with it, that is, the immediate succession of opposites, of conditions of the soul that are valued in morally opposed ways. People thought here they could get a grip on the fact that all of a sudden a “bad man” became a “saint,” a good man. On this point, psychology so far has suffered a shipwreck. Didn't that happen primarily because psychology subordinated itself to the control of morality, because it itself believed in opposing moral evaluations and saw, read into, and interpreted these opposites into the text and the facts? How's that? The “miracle” is only a failure of interpretation? A lack of philology?— 48 It seems that their Catholicism is much more inwardly bound up with the Latin races than all of Christianity is in general for us northerners and that, as a result, in Catholic countries unbelief means

something entirely different from what it means in Protestant countries—namely, a form of rebellion against the spirit of the race; whereas, among us unbelief means rather a turning back to the spirit (or non-spirit [Ungeist]) of the race. We northerners undoubtedly stem from races of barbarians, and this also holds with respect to our talent for religion. We are badly equipped for it. One can make the Celtic people an exception to that, and for this reason they also provided the best soil for the start of the Christian infection in the north:—in France the Christian ideal bloomed only as much as the pale northern sun permitted. How strangely devout for our taste even these recent French sceptics still are, to the extent they have some Celtic blood in their ancestry! How Catholic, how un-German, August Comte’s sociology smells to us, with its Roman logic of the instincts! How Jesuitical that charming and clever cicerone [tour guide] from Port Royal, Sainte-Beuve, in spite of all his hostility to the Jesuits! And then there’s Ernest Renan: how inaccessible to us northerners the language of such a Renan sounds, in which at every moment some nothing of religious tension destroys the equilibrium of his soul, which is, in a more refined sense, sensual and reclining comfortably! One should repeat after him these beautiful sentences—and how much malice and high spirits at once arise in response in our probably less beautiful and harder, that is, more German souls: “Let us then boldly assert that religion is a product of the normal man, that man is most in touch with truth when he is most religious and most assured of an infinite destiny . . . When he is good he wants virtue to correspond to an eternal order; when he contemplates things in a disinterested manner he finds death revolting and absurd. How can we not assume that it is in those moments like this that man sees best? . . .” These sentences are so entirely antithetical to my ears and habits that when I found them my initial rage wrote beside them “la niaiserie religieuse par excellence!” [the finest example of religious foolishness]—until my later anger really grew to like them, these sentences which turn the truth on its head! It is so nice, so distinguished, to have one’s very own antithesis!(5) 49 The thing that astonishes one about the religiosity of the ancient Greeks is the unrestrained fullness of gratitude which streams out of it:—it is a very noble kind of man who stands before nature and life in this way! Later, as the rabble gained prominence in Greece, fear grew all over religion as well, and preparations were made for Christianity. 50 The passion for God: there are sincere, peasant, pushy types, like Luther’s—all Protestantism lacks southern delicatessa [delicacy]. In it there is an oriental way of existing in an exalted state [Aussersichsein], as with a slave who, without deserving it, has been pardoned or ennobled, for example, Augustine, who lacks in an offensive way all nobility of gestures and desires. There is some feminine tenderness and desire in it which pushes itself bashfully and ignorantly towards a unio mystica et physica [a mystical and physical union], as with Madame de Guyon.(6) Strangely enough, in many cases it appears as a

disguise for puberty in a young woman or man, and here and there even as the hysteria of an old spinster, also as her last ambition:—in such cases the church has often already declared the woman a saint. 51 Up to now the most powerful people have still bowed reverently before the saint, as the riddle of self-conquest and of intentional final sacrifice. Why did they bow? They sensed in him—and, so to speak, behind the question mark of his frail and pathetic appearance—the superior power that wished to test itself in such a victory, the strength of the will, in which they knew how to recognize and honour their own strength and pleasure in mastery once more. They were honouring something in themselves when they revered the saint. It got to the point that the sight of a saint aroused a suspicion in them: such a monster of denial, something so contrary to nature, would not have been desired for no reason—that's what they said and questioned themselves about. Perhaps there is a reason for that, a really great danger, about which the ascetic, thanks to his secret comforters and visitors might provide more precise information? In short, the powerful people of the earth learned from the saint a new fear; they sensed a new power, a strange, as yet unconquered enemy:—it was the “will to power” which compelled them to halt in front of the saint. They had to ask him— 52 In the Jewish “Old Testament,” the book of divine justice, there are human beings, things, and speeches of such impressive style that the world of Greek and Indian literature has nothing to place beside them. We stand with fear and reverence before these tremendous remnants of what human beings once were and will in the process suffer melancholy thoughts about old Asia and its small protruding peninsula of Europe, which, in marked contrast to Asia, would like to represent the “progress of man.” Naturally, whoever is, in himself, only a weak, tame domestic animal and knows only the needs of domestic animals (like our educated people nowadays, including the Christians of “educated” Christianity), among these ruins such a man finds nothing astonishing or even anything to be sad about—a taste for the Old Testament is a touchstone with respect to “great” and “small”:—perhaps he finds the New Testament, that book of grace, still preferable to his heart (in it there is a good deal of the really tender, stifling smell of sanctimonious and small-souled people). To have glued together this New Testament, a sort of rococo of taste in all respects, with the Old Testament into a single book, as the “Bible,” and “the essential book,” that is perhaps the greatest act of daring and “sin against the spirit” that literary Europe has on its conscience. 53 Why atheism today?—“The father” in God has been fundamentally disproved, as well as “the judge,” “the rewarder.” Together with his “free will.” He is not listening—and if he were to hear, he wouldn't know how to help anyway. The worst thing is this: he appears incapable of communicating clearly. Is he indistinct?—From a number of different conversations, asking and listening, this is what I have unearthed as the cause of the decline of European theism: it seems to me that the religious instinct is, in

fact, growing powerfully—but that it is rejecting, with profound distrust, theistic satisfaction. 54 When you get down to it, what has all recent philosophy been doing? Since Descartes—and, in fact, more in defiance of him than on the basis of what he had done before—all philosophers have been trying to assassinate the old idea of the soul, under the appearance of a critique of the idea of the subject and predicate—that means an attempt to kill the basic assumption of Christian teaching. More recent philosophy, as an epistemological scepticism, is, in a concealed or open manner, anti-Christian, although (and this is said for more refined ears) in no way anti-religious. Formerly, that is, people believed in “the soul,” as they believed in grammar and the grammatical subject. They said “I” is the condition, “think” is the predicate and conditioned—thinking is an activity for which a subject must be thought of as cause. Now, people tried, with an admirable tenacity and trickery, to see whether they could get out of this net, whether perhaps the opposite might not be true: “think” as the condition, “I” the conditioned—thus “I” is only a synthesis that is itself created by thinking. Basically Kant wanted to show that if we started with the subject we could not prove the subject—or the object. The possibility of an apparent existence of the subject, hence “the soul,” might not have always been alien to him—that thought which, as Vedanta philosophy, was once before present with enormous power on earth.(7) 55 There is a huge ladder of religious atrocities, with many rungs. But three of them are the most important. First people sacrificed human beings to their gods, perhaps the very ones whom they loved best. Here belong the sacrifices of the first-born in all prehistoric religions, as well as the sacrifice of Emperor Tiberius in the grotto to Mithras on the island of Capri, that most terrible of all Roman anachronisms.(8) Then, in the moral ages of humanity, people sacrificed to their gods the strongest instincts that man possessed, his “nature.” This celebratory joy sparkles in the cruel glance of the ascetic, of the enthusiastic “anti-natural man.” Finally, what was still left to sacrifice? Did people not finally have to sacrifice everything comforting, holy, healing, all hope, all belief in a hidden harmony, in future blessedness and justice? Did people not have to sacrifice God himself and, out of cruelty against themselves, worship stone, stupidity, gravity, fate, and nothingness? To sacrifice God for nothingness—this paradoxical mystery of the last act of cruelty has been reserved for the generation which is coming along right now. We all already know something about this. 56 Anyone who, like me, has, with some enigmatic desire or other, made an effort for a long time to think profoundly about pessimism and to rescue it from the half-Christian, half-German restrictions and simple-mindedness with which it has most recently appeared in this century, that is, in the form of Schopenhauer’s philosophy; anyone who really has, with an Asiatic and super-Asiatic eye, looked into and down on the most world-denying of all possible ways of thinking—beyond good and evil and no longer as Buddha

and Schopenhauer do, under the spell and delusion of morality—such a man has perhaps in the process, without really wanting to do so, opened his eyes for the reverse morality: for the ideal of the most high-spirited, most lively, and most world-affirming human being, who has not only learned to come to terms with and to accept what was and is but who wants to have what was and is come back for all eternity, calling out insatiably *da capo* [from the beginning], not only to himself but to the entire play and spectacle, and not only to a spectacle but basically to the one who needs this particular spectacle and who makes the spectacle necessary, because over and over again he needs himself—and makes himself necessary. How's that? Wouldn't this be *circulus vitiosus deus* [god as a vicious circle]? 57 With the power of his spiritual glance and insight the distance and, as it were, the space around man expand: his world becomes deeper; new stars and new riddles and pictures always come into his view. Perhaps everything on which the eye of his spirit has practised its astuteness and profundity was just an excuse for exercise, a matter of play, something for children and childish heads. Perhaps one day the most solemn ideas, the ones over which we have fought and suffered the most, the ideas of "God" and "sin," will seem to us no more important than a children's toy or childish pain appears to an old man—and perhaps then "the old man" will need again another children's toy and another pain—still sufficiently a child, an eternal child! 58 Have people properly considered just how much a genuinely religious life (both its favourite task of microscopic self-examination and that tender calmness which is called "prayer" and is a constant preparedness for the "coming of God") requires an outward leisure or half-leisure—I mean leisure with a good conscience, time-honoured, from blood, something not entirely foreign to the aristocratic feeling that work is dishonourable (that is, the feeling that work makes the soul and body coarse) and how, as a result, the modern blaring, time-consuming industriousness, so proud of itself, stupidly proud, trains and prepares people, better than anything else, precisely for "unbelief"? For example, among the present inhabitants of Germany who live without religion, I find people who hold to "free-thinking" of various kinds and origins, but above all a majority of those whose industriousness, from generation to generation, has dissolved the religious instincts, so that these people no longer have any idea what purpose religions serve and take note of their presence in the world with, as it were, only a kind of indifferent wonder. They already feel that generous demands are made of them, these good people, whether from their businesses or their pleasures, to say nothing of the "Fatherland" and the newspapers and the "obligations to the family": it seems that they have no time at all left over for religion; it is especially unclear to them whether religion involves a new business or a new pleasure—for it's not possible, they tell themselves, that people go to church merely to spoil their own good moods. They are no enemies of religious customs.

If, in certain circumstances, people demand of them participation in such traditions (something required by the state, for example), they do what is required, just the way people do so many things—with a patient and modest seriousness and without much curiosity and concern. They just live too much apart and on the outside to find it necessary in such cases to conduct an argument with themselves for or against the matter. Among these indifferent people nowadays belongs the majority of German Protestants in the middle classes, particularly in the great industrious centres of trade and business, including most of the hard-working scholars and all the accessories of the university (with the exception of the theologians, whose existence and possibility there constantly provide the psychologist with more and ever more sophisticated riddles to sort out). Devout or merely church-going people rarely imagine how much good will—one could say how much arbitrary will—is involved nowadays when a German scholar takes the problem of religion seriously. On the basis of his whole trade (and, as mentioned, on the basis of the industriousness of the tradesman, which his modern conscience requires of him) he inclines to a supercilious, almost kindly amusement towards religion, mixed now and then with a slight contempt for the “uncleanliness” of the spirit which he assumes is present wherever people still profess their faith in the church. The scholar succeeds only with the help of history (hence not from his own personal experience) in bringing to religion a reverent seriousness and a certain timid consideration. But even if his feelings about religion have managed to rise all the way to gratitude towards it, in his own person he has not yet come a step closer to what still constitutes church and piety: perhaps the reverse is the case. The practical indifference to religious matters in which he was born and raised tends to sublimate itself in him to caution and cleanliness, things which avoid contact with religious people and things. And it can well be the very depth of his tolerance and humanity that tells him to stay out of the way of complex difficulties which tolerance brings with it. Every period has its own divine form of naiveté whose invention other ages may envy:—and how much naiveté, respectful, childish, and boundlessly foolish naiveté lies in this belief of the scholar in his own superiority, in the good conscience of his toleration, in the unsuspecting, unsophisticated certainty with which his instinct treats religious people as a less worthy and lower type, above whom he himself has grown up, out, and above—the scholar, the small, presumptuous dwarf and member of the rabble, the diligent and nimble head-and-hand-worker of “ideas,” of “modern ideas”! 59 Whoever has looked deep into the world will readily guess what wisdom exists in the fact that human beings are superficial. It is their preserving instinct, which teaches them to be changeable, light, and false. Here and there we find a passionate and exaggerated veneration of “pure forms,” among philosophers as well as among artists. No one should doubt that whoever requires the cult of surfaces that much has at some

time or another grasped beneath those surfaces, with unhappy results. Perhaps with respect to these scorched children, the born artists, who still find the good things of life only in the intention to falsify its image (as it were, in a prolonged revenge against life), there is even a rank ordering: we could derive the degree to which life has been spoiled for them by the extent to which they wish to see its image falsified, diluted, transcended, deified. Among the artists we could count the *homines religiosi* [men of religion] as their highest rank. It is the deep suspicious fear of an incurable pessimism which compels entire millennia to sink their teeth into a religious interpretation of existence, the fear arising from that instinct which has a premonition that people could grasp the truth too early, before humans have become strong enough, hard enough, artistic enough. . . . From this point of view, piety, the “life in God,” could appear as the most refined and final spawn of the fear of truth, as an artist’s worship and intoxication in the face of the most consequential of all falsifications, as the will to the reversal of the truth, to untruth at any price. Perhaps up to this point there has been no stronger way of making human beings themselves look more beautiful than this very piety: through it man can become so much art, surface, play of colours, and goodness, that we no longer suffer at the sight of him.— 60 To love human beings for the sake of God—so far that has been the most noble and most remote feeling that has been attained among men. The fact that without some consecrating intention behind it the love of human beings is one more stupidity and brutishness, that the inclination to this love of humanity must first derive its extent, delicacy, its grains of salt and specks of ambergris from some higher inclination—whatever human being it happened to be who first felt and “experienced” this, no matter how much his tongue may have stumbled as it tried to express such a delicacy, let him remain for all time sanctified among us and worthy of reverence as the man who so far has flown the highest and has lost his way most beautifully! 61 The philosopher the way we understand him, we free spirits, as the man of the most all-encompassing responsibility, who has the conscience for the collective development of human beings—this philosopher will help himself to religions for use in his work of cultivation and education, just as he will use contemporary political and economic conditions. The selective and cultivating influence—that is to say always both the destructive as well as the creative and shaping influence—which can be practised with the help of religions is something multifaceted and different, according to the type of people who are put under its spell and protection. For strong, independent people, those prepared and predestined to command, those in whom the reason and culture of a ruling race become something living, religion is one more means of overcoming resistance, so that they will be able to rule; it is like a bond which ties ruler and subjects together in common and betrays and hands over to the former the consciences of the latter, something hidden in their innermost selves which

would like to evade obedience. And in the event a few individual natures of such noble descent, because of their high mindedness, feel drawn towards a more secluded and more peaceful life and reserve for themselves only the most refined form of ruling (over chosen disciples or brethren in an order), then religion itself can be used as a means to create some peace for oneself from the noise and hardship of the cruder forms of ruling and cleanliness from the dirt which necessarily comes with all political action. That's something the Brahmin, for example, understood: with the help of a religious organization they arrogated to themselves the power to appoint a king for the people, while they held and felt themselves apart and outside, as men with higher purposes beyond kingship.(9) Meanwhile, religion also provides instruction for some of the ruled and an opportunity to prepare themselves for ruling and ordering in the future, those slowly ascending classes and groups, that is, those in which, because of fortunate marriage traditions, the force and desire of the will, the will to rule oneself, is always rising;—to these people religion offers sufficient stimuli and temptations to travel the route to a higher spirituality, to test the feelings of great self-conquest, of silence and solitude:—asceticism and Puritanism are almost indispensable means for educating and ennobling people when a race wishes to become master of its origins from the rabble and works its way up towards future ruling power. Finally, for ordinary people, the vast majority, who are there to serve for common needs and are permitted to exist only for that purpose, religion gives an invaluable modest satisfaction with their situation and type, all sorts of peace at heart, an ennoblement of obedience, one more source of joy and suffering with people like them, and something of a transfiguration and beautification of and a justification for the whole routine, the whole baseness, the whole half-animal poverty of their souls. Religion and the religious significance of life bring the brilliance of the sun onto such constantly troubled people and make them capable of tolerating the sight of themselves. Religion works just as an Epicurean philosophy usually works on suffering people of a higher rank—refreshing and refining and, as it were, exploiting the suffering, finally even blessing and justifying it.(10) In Christianity and Buddhism there is perhaps nothing so venerable as their art of teaching even the most abject people to place themselves, through their piety, into an illusory higher order of things and thus to hang onto their satisfaction with the real order, in the middle of which their life is hard enough—and this hardness is precisely what's necessary! 62 Finally, of course, to evaluate the opposing bad effects of such religions, as well, and to bring to light their sinister danger, there is always an expensive and fearful price to pay when religions prevail, not as a means of cultivation and education in the hand of philosophers, but as some inherently sovereign power, when religions want themselves to be the final purpose and not a means alongside other means. Among human beings, as among all other animal species, there is an excess of

failures, invalids, degenerates, and infirm individuals, those who necessarily suffer. Successful examples are always the exception, among human beings as well, and, given that man is the as-yet-undetermined animal, the rare exception. But even worse: the higher the type of human being a particular person represents, the more improbable it becomes that he will be successful. The contingent, the law of absurdity in the collective household of humanity, reveals itself in the most frightening manner in its destructive effects on the higher people, whose conditions of life are refined, multifaceted, and hard to estimate. Now, how do the two greatest religions mentioned above stand in relation to this excess of unsuccessful cases? They seek to preserve, to maintain alive, anything which merely allows itself to be preserved. In fact, they side with these unsuccessful cases, in principle, as religions for those who suffer; they agree that all those who suffer from life as from some illness are right, and they would like to see to it that every other feeling of life was judged false and became impossible. Even if we still wish to fix a high value on this protecting and preserving care, inasmuch as it is concerned and has been concerned with, among all the other people, the highest type of human being as well, the one who up to this point has almost always suffered the most, nonetheless in the total reckoning, the religions so far, that is, the sovereign religions, belong among the major causes which have kept the type “man” on a lower rung—they have preserved too much of what should have perished. We have to thank them for something invaluable, and who is rich enough in gratitude not to become poor in the face of everything which, for example, the “spiritual men” of Christianity have done for Europe up to this point? And yet, if they gave consolation to sufferers, courage to the oppressed and despairing, a staff and support to those who could not stand on their own, and enticed away from society and into monasteries and spiritual penitentiaries those suffering from inner destruction and those who had become wild, what must they have done in addition, in order to work in this way in good conscience basically for the preservation of everything sick and suffering, which amounts, in fact and truth, for the deterioration of the European race? Turn all evaluations of worth on their heads—that is what they had to do! Break up the strong men, infect great hopes, bring joy in beauty under suspicion, twist all self-mastery, everything manly, lofty, domineering, all instincts characteristic of the highest and most successful of the type “man” into uncertainty, distressed conscience, and self-destruction, in fact, to turn all love for earthly things and for dominion over the earth into hatred for the earth and the earthly—that is the task the church gave itself and had to give itself, until finally in its estimation “unworldliness,” “lack of sensuality,” and “higher man” melted together into a single feeling. Suppose we could survey with the mocking and disinterested eye of an Epicurean god the strangely painful comedy of European Christianity, as crude as it is refined, I believe we would

find no end to our amazement and laughter. Does it not seem that for eighteen centuries there has been ruling over Europe a will to turn the human being into a sublime monstrosity? However, anyone who, with the opposite needs, no longer Epicurean, but with some divine hammer in his hand, were to approach this almost voluntary degeneration and decay of a human being, like the Christian European (Pascal, for example), would he not have to cry out with fury, pity, and horror, “You fools! You arrogant, pitying fools, what have you done here? Was that a work for your hands? What a mess you’ve made, ruining my most beautiful stone! What have you presumed?” What I wanted to say was this: Christianity has been the most disastrous sort of arrogance so far. Men not lofty and hard enough to be permitted to shape men as artists; men not strong and far-sighted enough to allow, with a sublime conquest of the self, the foreground law of thousand-fold failure and destruction to prevail; men not noble enough to see the abysmally different rank ordering, the gulfs separating ranks between man and man:—such men have, with their “equal before God,” so far ruled over the fate of Europe to the point where finally a diminished, almost ridiculous type has been bred, a herd animal, something obliging, sickly, and mediocre—the contemporary European. . . .

NOTES (1) The title of this section is “Das Religiöse Wesen”. Wesen has a number of meanings, including person, character, disposition, nature, soul, mind, essence, inclination. [Back to Text] (2) Blaise Pascal (1623-1662), a brilliant French mathematician known for the extreme strictness and mortification of his religious beliefs. [Back to Text] (3) Martin Luther (1483-1546), German monk and theologian whose work launched the Reformation and Protestantism; Oliver Cromwell (1599-1658), English Protestant leader against King Charles I and founder of the Commonwealth (the short-lived English experiment with republican government). [Back to Text] (4) Richard Wagner (1813-1883), German composer and essayist, famous for his operas; Kundry: a character in Wagner’s opera *Parsifal* (1882), the high messenger of the Holy Grail. [Back to Text] (5) August Comte (1798-1857), a French philosopher who founded positivism and is considered the father of modern sociology; Port Royal: an important French religious community in the seventeenth century which encouraged self-renunciation; Charles Augustin Sainte-Beuve (1804-1869), a prominent French poet and literary critic; Ernest Renan (1823-1892), a well-known French writer on Christianity. Nietzsche quotes the the French: “Disons donc hardiment que la religion est un produit de l’homme normal, que l’homme est le plus dans le vrai quand il est le plus religieux et le plus assuré d’une destine infini . . . C’est quand il est bon qu’il veut que la vertu corresponde á un ordre éternel, c’est quand il contemple les choses d’une manière désintéressée qu’il trouve la mort révoltante et absurde. Comment ne pas supposer que c’est dans ces moments lá, que l’homme voit le mieux? . . . [Back to Text] (6) Saint Augustine (345-430),

Bishop of Hippo, a key figure in the development of early Christianity; Madame de Guyon: a sixteenth-century French mystic. [Back to Text] (7) Vedanta: a philosophical tradition within Hinduism. [Back to Text] (8) Emperor Tiberius: the Roman emperor after Augustus (from 14 AD to 37 AD). [Back to Text] (9) Brahmin: the elite priesthood in Hinduism. [Back to Text] (10) Epicurean: a follower of Epicurus (341 BC-270 BC), who taught that the highest good was pleasure, especially contemplative pleasure. [Back to Text]

==== Part 4: Epigrams and Interludes

==== Friedrich Nietzsche BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL Translated by Ian Johnston, Vancouver Island University, Nanaimo, British Columbia, Canada
Students, teachers, artists, and members of the general public may download and distribute this text without permission and without charge. They may also freely edit the text for their own purposes. All commercial use of this translation, however, is forbidden without the permission of the translator. For comments and questions, please contact Ian Johnston. For a Rich Text Version (Word) of this text, please use the following link: [Beyond Good and Evil \[RTF\]](#) [Table of Contents for Beyond Good and Evil] PART FOUR APHORISMS AND INTERLUDES
63 Whoever is fundamentally a teacher takes all things seriously only in relation to his students—including even himself. 64 “Knowledge for its own sake,”—that is the ultimate snare which morality sets: with that one gets fully entangled once again in morality. 65 The charm of knowledge would be slight, if there were not so much embarrassment to overcome on the route to knowledge. 65a Man is most dishonest in relation to his god: he is not permitted to sin! 66 The inclination to diminish oneself, to let oneself be robbed, deceived, and exploited could be the shame of a god among men. 67 Love of one person is a barbarity: for it is practised at the expense of all the rest. Also the love of God. 68 “I have done that” says my memory. “I could not have done that” says my pride and remains implacable. Finally—my memory gives up. 69 One has watched life badly if one has not also seen the hand which, in a considerate manner—kills. 70 If a person has character, he still has his typical experience, which always repeats itself. 71 The wise man as astronomer: so long as you still feel the stars as something “above you,” you still lack the eye of a man who knows. 72 It’s not the strength but the duration of the lofty sensation that makes lofty people. 73 Whoever attains his ideal, in the act of doing just that goes beyond it. 73a Many peacocks hide their peacock’s tails from all eyes—and call that their pride. 74 A man with genius is unendurable if he does not possess at least two things in addition: gratitude and cleanliness. 75 The degree and type of the sexuality in a man extend all the way to the ultimate peak of his spirit. 76 Under conditions of peace the warlike man attacks himself. 77 With their

principles people want to tyrannize their habits or justify them or honour them or abuse them or hide them:—two men with the same principles probably want them for fundamentally different things. 78 Anyone who despises himself nonetheless still respects himself as the one doing the despising. 79 A soul which knows that it is loved but does not itself love reveals its bottom layers—its lowest stuff comes up. 80 A matter which is explained ceases to concern us.—What did that god mean who advised “Know thyself”? Does that not perhaps mean “Stop being concerned about yourself! Become objective!”—And Socrates? —And the “scientific man”?— 81 It is dreadful to die of thirst in the sea. Must you then salt your truth so much that it can no longer—quench thirst? 82 “Pity for everyone”—that would hard and tyrannical for you, my neighbour! 83 Instinct—when the house is burning, people forget even their noonday meal.—Indeed, but people later haul it out of the ashes. 84 Woman learns to hate to the extent that she forgets how to enchant. 85 The same emotions in men and women have, nonetheless, a different tempo. That’s the reason man and woman do not cease misunderstanding each other. 86 Behind all personal vanity women themselves always have their impersonal contempt—for “woman.” 87 Bound heart, free spirit.—When one binds one’s heart firmly and keeps it imprisoned, one can provide one’s spirit many freedoms: I have said that already once. But people do not believe me, provided that they do not already know it. . . . 88 We begin to mistrust very clever people when they become embarrassed. 89 Dreadful experiences lead one to wonder whether the person who undergoes them is not something dreadful. 90 Heavy, melancholy men become lighter precisely through what makes other people heavy, through hate and love, and for a while they come to their surface. 91 So cold, so icy that we burn our fingers on him! Every hand that grasps him pulls back!—And for that very reason many assume he is glowing hot. 92 For the sake of his good reputation who has not once—sacrificed himself? 93 In affability there is no hatred for humanity, but for that very reason there is too much contempt for humanity. 94 Maturity in a man: that means having found once again the seriousness which man had as a child, in play. 95 For someone to be ashamed of his immorality: that is a step on the staircase at the end of which he is also ashamed of his morality. 96 People should depart from life in the way Odysseus separated from Nausikaa—blessing it rather than in love with it.(1) 97 What? A great man? I always see only the actor of his own ideal. 98 If we train our conscience, it will kiss us at the very moment it bites us. 99 The disappointed man speaks:—“I listened for the echo, and I heard only praise—” 100 We all present ourselves to ourselves as more simple than we are: in this way we give ourselves a rest from our fellow human beings. 101 Today a man with knowledge might easily feel like god transformed into an animal. 102 To discover that one is loved in return should really bring the lover down about his beloved. “How’s that? Is this person modest enough to love even

you? Or stupid enough? Or—or—. . .” 103 The danger in happiness—”Now everything is turning out the best for me; now I love every destiny:—Who feels like being my destiny?” 104 It is not their love of humanity but the impotence of their love of humanity that prevents today’s Christians—from burning us. 105 For the free spirit, the “pious man of discovery”—the *pia fraus* [pious fraud] is even more contrary to his taste (against his “piety”) than the *impia fraus* [impious fraud]. Hence his deep lack of understanding of the church, the sort associated with the type “free spirit,”—as his lack of freedom. 106 Thanks to music even the passions enjoy themselves. 107 Once the decision has been made, to shut your ears even to the best counter-arguments: a sign of a strong character. Hence, an occasional will to stupidity. 108 There are no moral phenomena at all, but only a moral interpretation of phenomena. . . . 109 The criminal is often enough not equal to his action: he diminishes and disparages it. 110 The lawyers for a criminal are rarely sufficiently artistic to turn the beautiful terror of his action to the benefit of the person who did it. 111 Our vanity is most difficult to injure at the very point when our pride has just been hurt. 112 Anyone who feels himself predestined to observe and not to believe finds all those who believe too noisy and pushy: he fends them off. 113 “Do you want to win him over for yourself? Then make yourself embarrassed in front of him.—” 114 The immense expectation concerning sexual love and the shame in this expectation ruin all perspective in women from the beginning. 115 Where the game involves neither love nor hate, woman plays indifferently. 116 The great epochs of our lives occur when we acquire the courage to rename our evil quality our best quality. 117 The will to overcome an emotion is, in the final analysis, only the will of another emotion or of several other emotions. 118 There is an innocence in admiration: such innocence belongs to the man who does not yet have any idea that he, too, could at some point be admired. 119 The disgust with filth can be so great that it prevents us from cleansing ourselves—from “justifying” ourselves. 120 Sensuality often makes the growth of love too fast, so that the root remains weak and easy to rip out. 121 There’s something fine about the fact that God learned Greek when He wanted to become a writer—and that he did not learn it better. 122 To be happy over praise is with some men only a courtesy of the heart—and exactly the opposite of vanity of the spirit. 123 Even concubinage has been corrupted—by marriage. 124 The man who still rejoices while being burned at the stake is not triumphing over the pain but over the fact that he feels none of the pain where he expected to. A parable. 125 When we have to change our minds about anyone, we hold the awkwardness which he has thus created for us very much against him. 126 A people is nature’s detour to produce six or seven great men.—Yes, and then to get around them. 127 Science offends the modesty of all real women. With it they feel as if someone wanted to peek under their skin—or even worse, under their dress and finery. 128 The more abstract the truth

you wish to teach, the more you must still seduce the senses to it. 129 The devil has the widest perspectives for God; that's why he keeps himself so far away from Him—for the devil is the oldest friend of knowledge. 130 What someone begins to show itself when his talent subsides—when he stops showing what he can do. Talent is also finery, and finery is also a hiding place. 131 The sexes deceive themselves about each other: this happens because basically they honour and love only themselves (or, to put the matter more pleasantly, only their own ideal—). Hence, the man wants the woman to be peaceful—but woman, like a cat, is essentially not peaceful, however much she may have practised an appearance of peacefulness. 132 People are best punished for their virtues. 133 The man who does not know how to find the way to his own ideal lives more carelessly and impudently than the man without an ideal. 134 All credibility, all good conscience, all appearance of the truth come only from the senses. 135 Pharisaism is not degeneration in a good man: a good part of it is rather the condition of all being-good [Gut-sein](2) 136 One man seeks a midwife for his ideas; another seeks someone he can help: that's how a good conversation arises. 137 By associating with scholars and artists one easily makes mistakes in reverse directions: behind a remarkable scholar we not infrequently find a mediocre human being, and behind a mediocre artist we often find—a very remarkable human being. 138 We act while awake as we do in a dream: we invent and fabricate the person with whom we associate—and then we immediately forget the fact. 139 In revenge and love woman is more barbaric than man. 140 Advice as riddle:—"If the bond is not to break—you must first bite down on it." 141 The lower abdomen is the reason man does not so easily consider himself a god. 142 The most demure saying I have ever heard: "In true love it's the soul that envelops the body."(3) 143 What we do best our vanity wishes to count as the thing that is most difficult for us. On the origin of many a morality. 144 When a woman has scholarly inclinations, then something is usually wrong with her sexuality. Infertility itself tends to encourage a certain masculinity of taste, for man is, if I may say so, "the infertile animal." 145 In comparing man and woman in general, we can say that woman would not have the genius for finery if she did not have the instinct for the secondary role. 146 Anyone who fights with monsters should make sure that he does not in the process become a monster himself. And when you look for a long time into an abyss, the abyss also looks into you. 147 From old Florentine novels, and in addition from life: *buona femmina e mala femmina vuol bastone* [the good woman and the bad woman want a stick]. Sacchetti, Nov. 86.(4) 148 To seduce a neighbour into a good opinion and, beyond that, to believe faithfully in this opinion of one's neighbour: who can match women in performing this trick?— 149 What an age finds evil is commonly an anachronistic echo of what previously was found to be good—the atavism of an older ideal. 150 Around the

hero everything becomes a tragedy, around the demi-god everything becomes a satyr play, and around God everything becomes—what? Perhaps a “world”?—
 151 Having a talent is not enough: one must also have your permission to have it —isn’t that so, my friends 152 “Where the tree of knowledge stands is always paradise”: that’s what the oldest and the most recent serpents declare. 153 What is done out of love always happens beyond good and evil. 154 Objection, evasion, cheerful mistrust, and love of mockery are indications of health: everything absolute belongs to pathology. 155 A sense of tragedy ebbs and flows with sensuality. 156 With individuals madness is something rare—but with groups, parties, peoples, and ages it’s the rule. 157 The thought of suicide is a strong consolation: with it people get through many a bad night. 158 Not only our reason but also our conscience submits to our strongest drive, the tyrant in us. 159 People must repay good and bad things, but why directly to the person who did good or bad things to us? 160 We no longer love our knowledge enough, once we have communicated it. 161 Poets are shameless about their experiences: they exploit them. 162 “Our neighbour [Nächster] is not our neighbour [Nachbar] but our neighbour’s neighbour”—that’s how every nation thinks.(5) 163 Love brings to light the high and the hidden characteristics of the person who loves—what is rare and exceptional about him: to that extent it easily misleads us about what is normal in him. 164 Jesus said to his Jews: “The law was for slaves—love God as I love him, as his son! What do we sons of God have to do with morality!” 165 Concerning every party: a shepherd always needs to have a bellwether—or he himself must from time to time be a wether. 166 People do lie with their mouths, but by the way they distort their mouths in doing so they nonetheless still speak the truth. 167 With hard people intimacy is shameful thing—and something precious. 168 Christianity gave Eros poison to drink—but he didn’t die from that. Instead he degenerated into a vice. 169 To talk a lot about oneself can also be a means of hiding oneself. 170 In praise there is more pushiness than in blame. 171 Pity in a man of knowledge seems almost laughable, like soft hands on a Cyclops.(6) 172 From love of humanity people sometimes embrace anyone (because they cannot embrace everyone): but that’s something they cannot reveal to this anyone. . . . 173 A man does not hate so long as his assessments are still low, but only when his assessments are equal or higher. 174 You utilitarians, even you love everything utile [useful] only as a cart to carry your inclinations—and don’t you really find the noise of its wheels unbearable? 175 Ultimately one loves one’s desire and not the object one desires. 176 The vanity of others goes against our taste only when it offends our vanity. 177 Concerning what “truthfulness” is, perhaps no one has yet been sufficiently truthful. 178 We do not believe in the foolishness of clever men: what a loss of human rights! 179 The consequences of our actions grab us by the hair, extremely indifferent to whether we have “improved” in the meantime. 180

There is an innocence in lying which indicates good faith in a cause. 181 It is inhuman to bless where one is cursed. 182 The familiarity of a superior person embitters, because it cannot be returned. 183 “What has shaken me is not that you lied to me but that I no longer believe you.”— 184 There is a high-spirited goodness which looks like malice. 185 “I dislike him.”—Why?—“I’m no match for him.”—Has a person ever answered in this way? NOTES (1) Nausikaa: a young princess in Homer’s *Odyssey*. [Back to Text] (2) Pharisaism: hypocritical observance of religious or moral laws. [Back to Text] (3) Nietzsche quotes the French: “Dans le véritable amour c’est l’âme, qui enveloppe le corps.” [Back to Text] (4) Franco Sacchetti (c. 1335-c.1400), Florentine writer. [Back to Text] (5) This enigmatic sentence seems to mean that our neighbour in a religious sense (“Love thy neighbour as thyself”) is not the person nearest to us (i.e., our literal neighbour) but rather the neighbour of someone else living close beside us. [Back to Text] (6) Cyclops: in Greek mythology a giant, one-eyed monster. [Back to Text]

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 === Part 5: On the Natural History of Morals
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=== Friedrich Nietzsche BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL Translated by Ian Johnston, Vancouver Island University, Nanaimo, British Columbia, Canada
 Students, teachers, artists, and members of the general public may download and distribute this text without permission and without charge. They may also freely edit the text for their own purposes. All commercial use of this translation, however, is forbidden without the permission of the translator. For comments and questions, please contact Ian Johnston. For a Rich Text Version (Word) of this text, please use the following link: [Beyond Good and Evil \[RTF\]](#) [Table of Contents for Beyond Good and Evil] PART FIVE A NATURAL HISTORY OF MORALS 186 Moral feeling in Europe is now just as refined, old, multifaceted, sensitive, and sophisticated as the “science of morality” associated with it is still young, amateurish, awkward, and fumbling:—an attractive contrast which now and then even becomes visibly incorporated in the person of a moralist. Even the phrase “science of morality” is, so far as what it designates is concerned, much too arrogant and contrary to good taste, which tends always to prefer more modest terms. We should in all seriousness admit to ourselves what we still need to do at this point and for a long time to come, the only thing that is justified at the moment, that is, to assemble materials, to organize conceptually and set in order an immense realm of delicate feelings of value and differences in values, which live, grow, reproduce, and die off—and, perhaps, to attempt to clarify the recurring and more frequent forms of these living crystallizations—as a preparation for a theory of types of morality. Naturally, so far we have not been so modest. As soon as philosophers busied themselves with morality as a science,

they collectively have demanded from themselves, with a formal seriousness which makes one laugh, something very much higher, more ambitious, more solemn. They wanted a rational basis for morality—and every philosopher so far has believed that he has provided such a rational grounding. But morality itself has been considered something “given.” How distant from their stodgy pride lay that apparently unspectacular task, left in the dust and mould, of a description, although for that work the subtlest hands and senses could hardly be subtle enough! The very fact that moral philosophers had only a crude knowledge of the moral facta [facts], in an arbitrary selection or an accidental abbreviation, something like the morality of their surroundings, their class, their church, the spirit of their age, their climate and region of the world—the very fact that they were poorly educated and not even very curious with respect to peoples, ages, and past events—meant that they never confronted at all the essential problems of morality—all of which emerge only with a comparison of several moralities. In all the “science of morality” up to this point what is still lacking, odd as it may sound, is the problem of morality itself. What’s missing is the suspicion that here there may be something problematic. What philosophers have called a “rational grounding of morality” and demanded from themselves was, seen in the right light, only a scholarly version of good faith in the ruling morality, some new way of expressing it, and thus itself an element in the middle of a determined morality, even indeed, in the final analysis, a form of denial that this morality could be grasped as a problem—and, at any rate, the opposite of a test, analysis, questioning, or vivisection of this particular belief. Listen, for example, to how even Schopenhauer presents his own task with such an almost admirable innocence, and draw your own conclusions about the scientific nature of a “science” whose ultimate masters still talk like children and little old women: “The principle,” he says (on p. 136 of *The Fundamental Problems of Morality*), “the basic assumption whose meaning all ethicists are essentially in agreement about—*neminem laede, immo omnes, quantum potes, juve* [hurt no one, instead help everyone, as much as you can]—that is essentially the principle which all teachers of morality struggle to ground in reason . . . the essential foundation of ethics, which people have been seeking for thousands of years, like the philosophers’ stone.” The difficulty of rationally grounding the principle quoted above may, of course, be considerable—as we know, it’s not something even Schopenhauer was successful in doing—and whoever has once thoroughly understood just how tastelessly false and sentimental this principle is in a world whose essence is the will to power might like to recall that Schopenhauer, although a pessimist, actually—played the flute. . . . Every day, after his meal: just read his biographer on this point. And here’s an incidental question: a pessimist, a man who denies God and the world, who stops in front of morality—who says yes to morality, to the *laede-neminem* [hurt no

one] morality, and blows his flute—How's that? Is that really—a pessimist? 187 Even apart from the value of such claims as "There is in us a categorical imperative," we can still always ask: What does such a claim express about the person making it? There are moralities which are intended to justify their creator before other people; other moralities are meant to calm him down and make him satisfied with himself; with others he wants to nail himself to the cross and humiliate himself; with others he wants to carry out revenge; with others to hide himself; with others to be transfigured and set himself above, high up and far away. This morality serves its originator so that he forgets; that morality so that he or something about him is forgotten; some moralists may want to exercise their power and creative moods on humanity, some others, perhaps even Kant as well, want us to understand with their morality: "What is respectable about me is that I can obey—and things should be no different for you than they are for me"—in short, moralities are also only a sign language of the feelings. 188 Every morality is—in contrast to *laissez aller* [letting go]—a part of tyranny against "nature," also against "reason": that is, however, not yet an objection to it. For to object, we would have to decree, once again on the basis of some morality or other, that no forms of tyranny and irrationality are permitted. The essential and invaluable part of every morality is that it is a lengthy compulsion: to understand Stoicism or Port Royal or Puritanism we should remember the compulsion under which every language so far has acquired strength and freedom—the metrical compulsion, the tyranny of rhyme and rhythm. In every people how much trouble poets and orators have made for themselves!—not excepting some contemporary prose writers in whose ears a relentless conscience dwells—"for the sake of some foolishness," as utilitarian fools say, who think that makes them clever, —"out of obsequiousness to arbitrary laws," as the anarchists say, who think that makes them "free," even free spirited.(1) The strange fact, however, is that everything there is or has been on earth to do with freedom, refinement, boldness, dance, and masterly certainty, whether it is in thinking itself, or in governing, or in speaking and persuading, in the arts just as much as in morals, has developed only thanks to the "tyranny of such arbitrary laws," and in all seriousness, the probability is not insignificant that it is precisely this that is "nature" and "natural"—and not that *laissez aller*! Every artist knows how far from the feeling of letting himself go his "most natural" condition is, the free ordering, setting, disposing, and shaping in moments of "inspiration"—and how strictly and subtly he obeys at that very moment the thousand-fold laws which make fun of all conceptual formulations precisely because of their hardness and decisiveness (even the firmest idea, by comparison, contains something fluctuating, multiple, ambiguous—). The essential thing "in heaven and on earth," so it appears, is, to make the point again, that there is obedience for a long time and in one direction: in the process eventually there comes and always has

come something for whose sake living on earth is worthwhile, for example, virtue, art, virtue, music, dance, reason, spirituality—something or other transfiguring, subtle, fantastic, and divine. The long captivity of the spirit, the mistrustful compulsion in our ability to communicate our thoughts, the discipline which the thinker imposed on himself to think within the guiding principles of a church or court or with Aristotelian assumptions, the long spiritual will to interpret everything which happens according to a Christian scheme and to discover and justify the Christian god once again in every coincidence—all this powerful, arbitrary, hard, dreadful, anti-rational activity has turned out to be the means by which the European spirit has cultivated its strength, its reckless curiosity, and its subtle flexibility. Admittedly by the same token a great deal of irreplaceable force and spirit must have been overwhelmed in the process, crushed, and ruined as well (for here, as everywhere, “nature” reveals herself as she is, in her totally extravagant and indifferent magnificence, which is an outrage, but something noble). The fact that for thousands of years European thinkers only thought in order to prove something—nowadays, by contrast, we distrust any thinker who “wants to prove something”—and that for them what was to emerge as the result of their strictest thinking was always already clearly established, as in something like Asiatic astrology earlier or the harmless Christian moralistic interpretation of the most intimate personal experience “for the glory of God” or “for the salvation of the soul” still present today—this tyranny, this arbitrariness, this strict and grandiose stupidity, has trained the spirit. Apparently slavery is also, in the cruder and more refined sense, the indispensable means for disciplining and cultivating the spirit. We should examine every morality in the following way: “nature” in it is what teaches hatred of the *laissez aller*, of that all-too-great freedom, and what plants the need for limited horizons, for work close at hand—it teaches the narrowing of perspective and also, in a certain sense, stupidity as a condition of living and growth. “You are to obey someone or other and for a long time: otherwise you perish and lose final respect for yourself”—this seems to me to be the moral imperative of nature, which, of course, is neither “categorical,” as the old Kant wanted the imperative to be (hence the “otherwise”), nor directed at the individual (what does nature care about individuals?), but rather at peoples, races, ages, classes, but above all at the whole animal “man,” at the human being.

189 The industrious races complain a great deal about having to tolerate idleness: it was a masterpiece of the English instinct to make Sunday so holy and so tedious, a form of cleverly invented and shrewdly introduced fasting, that the Englishman, without being aware of the fact, became eager again for weekdays and workdays. Things like it are frequently seen also in the ancient world (even if, as is reasonable among southern people, not exactly connected to work—). There must be fasts of several kinds, and in every place where powerful impulses

and habits rule, the lawgivers have to take care to insert extra days in the calendar in which such an impulse is placed in chains and learns once again to go hungry. Seen from a higher viewpoint, the periods when entire races and ages get afflicted with some moral fanaticism or other look like such inserted times of compulsion and fasting, during which an impulse learns to cower down and abase itself, but also to cleanse and sharpen itself. Individual philosophical sects (for example the Stoa in the midst of Hellenistic culture and its lecherous air heavy with aphrodisiac scents) permit this sort of interpretation as well.—And with this we are also given a hint for an explanation of that paradox why it was precisely in Europe's Christian period and, in general, only under the pressure of Christian value judgments that the sex drive sublimated itself into love (amour-passion [passionate love]).

190 There is something in Plato's morality which does not really belong to Plato, but is found in his philosophy, one might say, only in spite of Plato, namely, the Socratism for which Plato was essentially too noble. "No one wants to injure himself; thus, everything bad happens unwillingly. For the bad man inflicts damage on himself: he would not do that, if he knew that bad is bad. Thus, the bad man is bad only from error. If we take his error away from him, we necessarily make him—good." This sort of argument stinks of the rabble, which in the case of bad actions fixes its eyes only on the wretched consequences and really makes the judgment "It is stupid to act badly," while "good" it assumes without further thought is identical to "useful and agreeable." So far as every utilitarianism of morality is concerned, we may guess from the start that it had an origin like this and follow our noses: we will seldom go wrong.—Plato did everything to interpret something refined and noble in the proposition of his teacher, above all, himself—Plato, the most daring of all interpreters, took all of Socrates only like a popular tune and folk song from the alleys, in order to change it into infinite and impossible variations, that is, into all his own masks and multiplicities. To speak in jest—and one based on Homer: What is the Platonic Socrates if not prosthe Platon opithen te Platon messe te chimera [Plato in front, Plato behind, and in the middle the chimera]?(2)

191 The old theological problem of "believing" and "knowing"—or, to put the matter more clearly—of instinct and reason—and thus the question whether in assessing the value of things instinct deserves more authority than rationality, which wants to assess and act according to reasons, according to a "Why?"—according to expediency and utility—it is still that old moral problem, as it first appeared in the person of Socrates and had already divided minds long before Christianity. Socrates, in fact, with a taste for his talent—which was that of a superior dialectical thinker—set himself at first on the side of reason, and, in truth, what did he do his whole life long but laugh at the awkward inability of his noble Athenians, who were men of instinct, like all noble men, and who could never provide enough information about the reasons for their actions? Finally,

however, in stillness and in secret he also laughed at himself. With his more subtle conscience and self-enquiry he found in himself the same difficulty and inability. But, he said to himself, why does that mean releasing oneself from the instincts! We must give the instincts and reason the proper help. We must follow the instincts but convince reason to assist in the process with good arguments. This was the real falsehood of that great ironist, so rich in secrets. He brought his conscience to the point where it was satisfied with a kind of trick played on itself. Socrates basically had seen through the irrational in moral judgments. Plato, who was more innocent in such things and without the mischievousness of a common man, wanted to use all his power—the greatest power which a philosopher up to that time had had at his command!—to prove that reason and instinct inherently move towards a single goal, towards the good, towards “god,” and since Plato all theologians and philosophers have been on the same road—that is, in things concerning morality up to now, instinct, or as the Christians call it, “faith,” or, as I call it, “the herd,” has triumphed. We must grant that Descartes is an exception, the father of rationalism (and thus the grandfather of the Revolution), a man who conferred sole authority on reason. But reason is only a tool, and Descartes was superficial.(3) 192

Anyone who has followed the history of a single science finds in its development a text-book case for understanding the oldest and commonest events in all “knowing and perceiving.” In the former, as in the latter, the rash hypotheses, the fabrications, the good, stupid will to “believe,” the lack of suspicion and patience develop first of all—our senses learn late and never learn completely to be subtle, true, and cautious organs of discovery. With a given stimulus, our eye finds it more comfortable to produce once more an image which has already been produced frequently than to capture something different and new in an impression. To do the latter requires more power, more “morality.” To listen to something new is disconcerting and hard on our ears; we hear strange music badly. When we hear some different language, we spontaneously try to reshape the sounds we hear into words which sound more familiar and native to us: that’s how, for example, in earlier times, when the German heard the word *arcubalista* he changed it into *armbrust* [*arcubalista* . . . *armbrust*: crossbow]. Something new also finds our senses hostile and reluctant, and generally, even with the “simplest” perceptual processes, the emotions—like fear, love, hate, as well as the passive feeling of idleness—are in control.—Just as a reader nowadays hardly reads all the individual words (let alone the syllables) on a page—he’s much more likely to take about five words out of twenty at random and “guess” on the basis of these five words the presumed sense they contain—so we hardly look at a tree precisely and completely, considering the leaves, branches, colour, and shape; we find it so very much easier to imagine an approximation of the tree. Even in the midst of the most unusual experiences we still act in the same way: we make up

the greatest part of the experience for ourselves and are hardly ever compelled not to look upon any event as “inventors.” What all this adds up to is that basically from time immemorial we have been accustomed to lie. Or to express the matter more virtuously and hypocritically, in short, more pleasantly: we are much more the artist than we realize. In a lively conversation I often see in front of me the face of the person with whom I am speaking so clearly and subtly determined according to the idea which he expresses or which I think has been brought out in him that this degree of clarity far exceeds the power of my ability to see:—thus, the delicacy of the play of muscles and of the expression in his eyes must be something I have made up out of my own head. The person probably had a totally different expression or none at all. 193

Quidquid luce fuit, tenebris agit [What went on in the light, acts in the darkness], but the other way around as well. What we experience in a dream, provided we experience it frequently, finally is as much a part of the collective household of our souls as anything “truly” experienced. Thanks to this, we are richer or poorer, have one more need or one less, and finally in the bright light of day and even in the happiest moments of our waking spirit we are ordered around a little by the habits of our dreams. Suppose that an individual in his dreams has often flown and, finally, as soon as he dreams, becomes aware of the power and art of flying as his privilege and also as his own enviable happiness; such a man who believes he is capable of realizing every kind of curving or angled flight with the easiest impulse, who knows the feeling of a certain godlike carelessness, an “upward” without tension and compulsion, a “downward” without condescension and without humiliation—without gravity!—how should a man with such dream experiences and dream habits not also finally discover in his waking day that the word “happiness” has a different colour and definition! How could he not desire happiness in different way? “Soaring upward,” as described by poets, for him must be, in comparison with that “flying,” too earthbound, too muscular, too forceful, even too “heavy.” 194 The difference between men does not manifest itself only in the difference between the tables of the goods they possess, in other words, only in the fact that they consider different goods worth striving for and are at odds among themselves about what is more or less valuable, about the rank ordering of the commonly acknowledged goods—the difference becomes even clearer in what counts for them as really having and possessing something good. So far as a woman is concerned, for example, a more modest man considers having her body at his disposal and sexual gratification a satisfactory and sufficient sign of having, of possession. Another man, with his more suspicious and more discriminating thirst for possessions sees the “question mark,” the fact that such a possession is only apparent, and wants a more refined test, above all, to know whether the woman not only gives herself to him but also for his sake gives up what she has or would like to have. Only then does he consider her

“possessed.” A third man, however, is at this point still not finished with his suspicion and desire to possess. He asks himself if the woman, when she gives up everything for him, is not perhaps doing this for a phantom of himself: he wants to be well known first, fundamentally, even profoundly, in order to be able to be loved at all. He dares to allow himself to be revealed.—Only then does he feel that the loved one is fully in his possession, when she is no longer deceived about him, when she loves him just as much for his devilry and hidden insatiability as for his kindness, patience, and spirituality. One man wants to possess a people: and all the higher arts of Cagliostro and Catiline he thinks appropriate for this purpose.(4) Another, with a more refined thirst for possession, tells himself “One is not entitled to deceive where one wants to possess.”—He is irritated and impatient at the idea that a mask of him rules the hearts of his people: “Hence I must let myself be known and, first of all, learn about myself!” Among helpful and charitable people we find almost routinely that crude hypocrisy which first prepares the person who is to be helped, as if, for example, he “earns” help, wants precisely their help, and would show himself deeply thankful, devoted, and obsequious to them for all their help—with these fantasies they dispose of the needy as if they are property, as if they are, in general, charitable and helpful people out of a demand for property. We find them jealous if we cross them or anticipate them in their helping. Parents unwittingly make their child into something that resembles them—they call it “an upbringing”—no mother doubts at the bottom of her heart that with a child she has given birth to a possession; no father denies himself the right to be allowed to subjugate the child to his ideas and values. In fact, in earlier times it seemed proper for fathers to dispose of the life and death of newborns at their own discretion (as among the ancient Germans). And like the father, even today the teacher, the class, the priest, and the prince still see in each new human being a harmless opportunity for a new possession. And from that follows . . . 195 The Jews—a people “born for slavery,” as Tacitus and the entire ancient world say, “the chosen people among nations,” as they themselves say and believe—the Jews achieved the amazing feat of inverting values, thanks to which life on earth for two millennia has possessed a new and dangerous appeal.(5) Their prophets fused “rich,” “godless,” “evil,” “violent,” and “sensuous” into a unity and for the first time coined the word “world” as a word connoting shame. In this inversion of values (to which belongs the use of the word for “poor” as a synonym for “holy” and “friend”) lies the significance of the Jewish people: with them begins the slave rebellion in morality. 196 We can conclude that there are countless dark bodies in the region of the sun—bodies we will never see. Between us, that’s a parable, and a psychologist of morality reads the entire writing in the stars only as a language of parable and signs, something that allows a great deal to remain concealed. 197 We fundamentally misunderstand predatory animals and

predatory men (for example, Cesare Borgia), and we misunderstand “Nature,” so long as we still look for a “pathology” at the bottom of these healthiest of all tropical monsters and growths or even for some “Hell” born in them—as almost all moralists so far have done.(6) Among moralists does it not appear that there is hatred for the primeval forest and the tropics? And that the “tropical man” must at any price be discredited, whether as a sickness and degeneration of human beings or as his own hell and self-torture? But why? For the benefit of the “temperate zones”? For the benefit of the temperate human beings? For the “moral human beings”? For the mediocre? This for the chapter “morality as timidity.” 198 All these moralities that direct themselves at the individual person, for the sake of his “happiness,” as people say—what are they except proposals about conduct in relation to the degree of danger in which the individual person lives with himself, recipes against his passions, his good and bad inclinations, to the extent that they have a will to power and would like to play the master; small and great clever sayings and affectations, afflicted with the musty enclosed smell of ancient household remedies or old women’s wisdom, all baroque and unreasonable in form—because they direct themselves to “all,” because they generalize where we should not generalize—all speaking absolutely, taking themselves absolutely, all spiced with more than one grain of salt, and much more bearable, sometimes even seductive, when they learn to smell over-seasoned and dangerous, above all “of the other world.” By any intellectual standard, all that is worth little and still a far cry from “science,” to say nothing of “wisdom,” but, to say it again and to say it three times: prudence, prudence, prudence, mixed in with stupidity, stupidity, stupidity—whether it is now that indifference and coldness of an ornamental column against the hot-headed foolishness of the emotions, which the Stoics recommended and applied as a cure; or even that no-more-laughing and no-more-crying of Spinoza, his excessively naive support for the destruction of the emotions through analysis and vivisection; or that repression of the emotions to a harmless mean, according to which they should be satisfied, the Aristotelianism of morality; even morality as the enjoyment of emotions in a deliberate dilution and spiritualization through artistic symbolism, something like music or the love of God and love of man for the sake of God—for in religion the passions have civil rights once more, provided that . . . ; finally even that accommodating and wanton dedication to the emotions, as Hafis and Goethe taught, that daring permission to let go of the reins, that physical-spiritual *licentia morum* [moral licentiousness] in the exceptional examples of wise old owls and drunkards, for whom it “has little danger anymore.”(7) This also for the chapter “morality as timidity.” 199 Given that at all times, as long as there have been human beings, there have also been herds of human beings (racial groups, communities, tribes, peoples, states, churches) and always a great many followers in relation to the small number of

those issuing orders—and taking into consideration also that so far nothing has been better and longer practised and cultivated among human beings than obedience, we can reasonably assume that typically now the need for obedience is inborn in each individual, as a sort of formal conscience that states “You are to do something or other without conditions, and leave aside something else without conditions,” in short, “Thou shalt.” This need seeks to satisfy itself and to fill its form with some content. Depending on its strength, impatience, and tension, it seizes on something, without being very particular, like a coarse appetite, and accepts what someone or other issuing commands—parents, teachers, laws, class biases, public opinion—shouts in people’s ears. The curious limitation of human development—the way it hesitates, takes so long, often regresses, and turns around on itself—is based on the fact that the herd instinct of obedience is passed on best and at the expense of the art of commanding. If we imagine this instinct at some point striding right to its ultimate excess, then there would finally be a total lack of commanders and independent people, or they would suffer inside from a bad conscience and find it necessary first to prepare a deception for themselves in order to be able to command, as if they, too, were only obeying orders. This condition is what, in fact, exists nowadays in Europe: I call it the moral hypocrisy of those in command. They do not know how to protect themselves from their bad conscience except by behaving as if they were carrying out older or higher orders (from ancestors, the constitution, rights, law, or even God), or they even borrow herd maxims from the herd way of thinking, for example, as “the first servant of their people” or as “tools of the common good.” On the other hand, the herd man in Europe today makes himself appear as if he is the single kind of human being allowed, and he glorifies those characteristics of his thanks to which he is tame, easy going, and useful to the herd, as the really human virtues, that is, public spiritedness, benevolence, consideration, diligence, moderation, modesty, forbearance, and pity. For those cases, however, where people believe they cannot do without a leader and bellwether, nowadays they make attempt after attempt to replace the commander by adding together collections of clever herd people. All the representative constitutional assemblies, for example, have this origin. But for all that, what a blissful relief for these European herd animals, what a release from a pressure which is growing unbearable is the appearance of an absolute commander. The effect which the appearance of Napoleon made was the most recent major evidence for that:—the history of the effect of Napoleon is almost the history of the higher happiness which this entire century derived from its most valuable men and moments. 200 The man from an age of dissolution, which mixes the races all together, such a man has an inheritance of a multiple ancestry in his body, that is, conflicting and frequently not merely conflicting drives and standards of value, which war among themselves and rarely give each other rest

—such a man of late culture and broken lights will typically be a weaker man. His most basic demand is that the war which constitutes him should finally end. Happiness seems to him, in accordance with a calming medicine and way of thinking (for example, Epicurean or Christian), principally as the happiness of resting, of having no interruptions, of surfeit, of the final unity, as the “Sabbath of Sabbaths,” to use the words of the saintly rhetorician Augustine, who was himself such a man. But if the opposition and war in such a nature work like one more charm and thrill in life—and if, on the other hand, in addition to that nature’s powerful and irreconcilable drives it has also inherited and cultivated a real mastery and refinement in waging war with itself—in other words, controlling and outwitting the self, then arise those delightfully amazing and inexplicable people, those enigmatic men predestined for victory and seduction, whose most beautiful expressions are Alcibiades and Caesar (—in their company I’d like to place the first European, according to my taste, the Hohenstaufen Frederick II), and, among artists, perhaps Leonardo da Vinci.(8) They appear in precisely the same ages when that weaker type, with its demands for quiet, steps into the foreground: both types belong with one another and arise from the same causes. 201 As long as the utility which rules in moral value judgments is merely the utility of the herd, as long as our gaze is directed only at the preservation of the community and we look for what is immoral precisely and exclusively in what appears dangerous to the survival of the community, there can be no “morality of loving one’s neighbour.” Assuming there already exists in society a constant small habit of consideration, pity, fairness, kindness, and mutual assistance, assuming also that in this condition of society all those drives are already active which are later described with honourable names as “virtues” and which finally are almost synonymous with the idea “morality,” at that time they are not at all yet in the realm of moral value judgments—they are still outside morality. For example, a compassionate action in the best Roman period was called neither good nor evil, neither moral nor immoral. And even if it was praised, this praise brought with it at best still a kind of resentful disdain, as soon as it was compared with some action which served the demands of the totality, of the *res publica* [republic]. Ultimately the “love of one’s neighbour” is always something of secondary importance, partly conventional, arbitrary, and apparent, in relation to fear of one’s neighbour. After the structure of society in its entirety is established and seems secure against external dangers, it is this fear of one’s neighbour which creates once again new perspectives of moral value judgments. Certain strong and dangerous instincts, like a love of enterprise, daring, desire for revenge, shiftiness, rapacity, and thirst for power, which up to this point not only were honoured as useful to the community, under different names, of course, from those just chosen here, but had to be powerfully inculcated and cultivated (because people constantly needed them to cope with the dangers to the totality,

against the enemies of that totality)—these are now experienced as doubly dangerous—now that there is a lack of diversionary channels for them—and they are gradually abandoned, slandered, and branded as immoral. Now the opposing impulses and inclinations acquire moral honour. The herd instinct draws its conclusions, step by step. How much or how little something is dangerous to the community, dangerous to equality, in an opinion, in a condition and emotion, in a will, in a talent, that is now the moral perspective. Here also fear is once again the mother of morality. When the highest and strongest drives break out passionately and impel the individual far above and beyond the average and low level of the herd's conscience, the feeling of commonality in the community is destroyed; its belief in itself, its spine, as it were, breaks: as a result people brand these very drives and slander them most of all. The high independent spirituality, the will to stand alone, even powerful reasoning, are experienced as a danger. Everything which lifts the individual up over the herd and creates fear in his neighbour from now on is called evil. The proper, modest, conforming faith in equality, the happy medium in desires—these acquire honorable moral names. Finally, under very peaceful conditions, there is an increasing lack of opportunity and need to educate the feelings in strength and hardness. Now every severity, even in justice, begins to disrupt the conscience. A high and stern nobility and self-responsibility is almost an insult and awakens mistrust; “the lamb” and even more “the sheep” gain respect. There is a point of morbid decay and decadence in the history of society when it itself takes sides on behalf of the person who harms it, the criminal, and does so, in fact, seriously and honestly. Punishment: that seems to society somehow or other unreasonable. What's certain is that the idea of “punishment” and “We should punish” causes it distress, makes it afraid. “Is it not enough to make him un-dangerous? Why punish him as well? To punish is itself dreadful!”—with this question the morality of the herd, the morality of timidity, draws its final conclusion. Assuming people could, in general, do away with the danger, the basis of the fear, then people would have done away with this morality as well: it would no longer be necessary; it would no longer consider itself necessary! Whoever examines the conscience of the contemporary European will always have to pull out from the thousand moral folds and hiding places the same imperative, the imperative of the timidity of the herd: “Our wish is that at some point or other there is nothing more to fear(T)!” At some point or other—nowadays everywhere in Europe the will as well as the way to that point is called “progress.” 202 Let us state right away one more time what we have already said a hundred times, for today's ears don't listen willingly to such truths—to our truths. We know well enough how insulting it sounds when an individual reckons human beings in general plainly and simply and unmetaphorically among the animals, but one thing will make people consider us almost guilty, the fact that, so far as men of “modern ideas” are concerned, we

constantly use the terms “herd,” “herd instincts,” and the like. What is the point of that? We cannot do anything else: for precisely here lies our new insight. We have found that in all major moral judgments Europe, together with those countries where Europe’s influence dominates, has become unanimous. People in Europe evidently know what Socrates thought he did not know and what that famous old snake once promised to teach—today people “know” what good and evil are. Now, it must sound harsh and be hard on their ears when we keep claiming all the time that what here thinks it knows, what here glorifies itself with its praise and censure and calls itself good, is the instinct of the herd animal man, which has managed to break through, overpower, and dominate other instincts and continues increasingly to do so, in accordance with the growing physiological assimilation and homogeneity, whose symptom it is. Morality today in Europe is the morality of the herd animal—thus only, as we understand the matter, one kind of human morality, alongside which, before which, and after which there are many other possible moralities, above all higher ones, or there should be. Against such a “possibility,” in opposition to such a “should be,” however, this morality defends itself with all its forces: it says stubbornly and relentlessly, “I am morality itself, and nothing outside me is moral”—in fact, with the help of a religion which indulged and catered to the most sublime desires of the herd animal, it has reached the point where we find even in the political and social arrangements an ever more visible expression of this morality: the democratic movement has come into the inheritance of the Christian movement. But the fact is that its tempo is still much too slow and drowsy for the impatient, the sick, and those addicted to the above-mentioned instinct—evidence for that comes from the wailing, which grows constantly more violent, the increasingly open snarling fangs of the anarchist hounds who now swarm through the alleys of European culture, apparently in contrast to the peacefully industrious democrats and ideologues of the revolution, even more to the foolish pseudo-philosophers and those ecstatic about brotherhood, who call themselves socialists and want a “free society.” But in reality these anarchists are at one with all of them in their fundamental and instinctive hostility to every form of society other than one of the autonomous herd (all the way to the rejection of the very ideas of “master” and “servant”—*ni dieu ni maître* [neither god nor master] is the way one socialist formula goes—); at one in their strong resistance against all special claims, all special rights and privileges (that means, in the last analysis, against every right, for when all people are equal, then no one needs “rights” any longer—); at one in their mistrust of a justice which punishes (as if it were a violation of the weaker people, a wrong against the necessary consequence of all earlier society—); and equally at one in the religion of pity, in their sympathy for whatever merely feels, lives, or suffers (right down to the animals, right up to “God”):— the excessive outpouring of “suffering vicariously

with God” belongs to a democratic age—); at one collectively in their cries for and impatience in their pity, in their deadly hatred of suffering generally, in their almost feminine inability to stand there as spectators, to let suffering happen; at one in their involuntary gloom and softness, under whose spell Europe seems threatened by a new Buddhism; at one in their faith in the morality of mutual pity, as if that were morality in and of itself, as the height, the attained height of humanity, the sole hope of the future, a consolation for those now alive, the great absolution from all guilt of earlier times;—altogether at one in their belief in the community as the saviour, thus in the herd, in “themselves” . . . 203 We, the ones with a different belief—we, who consider the democratic movement not merely a degenerate form of political organization but a degenerate form of humanity, that is, something that diminishes humanity, makes it mediocre and of lesser worth, where do we have to reach out to with our hopes? There is no choice: we must reach for new philosophers, for spirits strong and original enough to provide the impetus for an opposing way of estimating value and to re-evaluate and invert “eternal values,” for those sent out as forerunners, for men of the future who at the present time establish the compulsion and the knot that forces the will of millennia into new paths. To teach man the future of humanity as his will, as dependent on a man’s will, and to prepare for great exploits and comprehensive attempts at discipline and cultivation, so as to put an end to that horrifying domination of nonsense and contingency which up to now has been called “history”—the nonsense of the “greatest number” is only its latest form:—for that a new type of philosophers and commanders will at some point be necessary, whose image will make all hidden, fearsome, and benevolent spirits on earth appear pale and dwarfish. The image of such leaders is what hovers before our eyes:—may I say that out loud, you free spirits? The conditions which we must partly create and partly exploit for the origin of these leaders, the presumed ways and trials thanks to which a soul might grow to such height and power to feel the compulsion for these tasks, a revaluation of values under whose new pressure and hammer a conscience would be hardened, a heart transformed to bronze, so that it might endure the weight of such responsibility and, on the other hand, the necessity for such leaders, the terrifying danger that they might not appear or could fail and degenerate—these are our real worries, the things that make us gloomy. Do you know that, you free spirits? These are the heavy, distant thoughts and thunderstorms which pass over the heaven of our life. There are few pains as severe as having once seen, guessed, and felt how an extraordinary man has gone astray and degenerated, but someone who has the rare eye for the overall danger that “man” himself is degenerating, someone who, like us, has recognized the monstrous accident which has played its game up to this point with respect to the future of humanity—a game in which there was no hand, not even a “finger of

god,” playing along!—someone who divines the fate which lies hidden in the idiotic innocence and the blissful trust in “modern ideas,” and even more in the entire Christian-European morality, such a man suffers from an anxiety which cannot be compared with any other—with one look, in fact, he grasps everything that still might be cultivated in man, given a favourable combination and increase of powers and tasks; he knows with all the knowledge of his conscience how the greatest possibilities for man have not yet been exhausted and how often the type man has already stood up to mysterious decisions and new paths:—he knows even better, from his own most painful memory, what wretched things have so far usually broken apart a developing being of the highest rank, shattered him, sunk him, and made him pathetic. The overall degeneration of man, down to what nowadays shows up in the socialist fools and flat heads, as their “man of the future”—as their ideal!—this degeneration and diminution of man to a perfect herd animal (or, as they say, to a man of “free society”), this beastialization of man into a dwarf animal of equal rights and claims is possible—no doubt of that! Anyone who has once thought this possibility through to its conclusion understands one more horror than other people do—and perhaps a new task, as well! . . .

NOTES (1) Stoicism: a Greek school of philosophy from the third century BC. It stressed the importance of overcoming one’s destructive emotions; Port Royal: a convent which became the centre of Jansenism, a challenge within the Catholic Church in the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries. [Back to Text] (2) The Greek alphabet in Nietzsche’s phrase (προσθε Πλατων οπιθεν Πλεσση τε Χιμαιρα) has here been transliterated into the Roman alphabet; Chimera: a fabulous Greek monster, with the head of a lion, the mid-section of a goat, and a dragon’s tail. [Back to Text] (3) René Descartes (1596-1650), French philosopher and mathematician, one of the most important figures in the development of modern science and philosophy. [Back to Text] (4) Cagliostro (1743-1795), a notorious Italian fraud; Catiline: Lucius Sergius Catilina (108-62 BC), a contemporary of Julius Caesar, famous as a devious political conspirator. [Back to Text] (5) Publius Cornelius Tacitus (56-117), famous Roman historian. [Back to Text] (6) Cesare Borgia (1475-1507), Italian statesman and general well known for his ruthlessness and duplicity. [Back to Text] (7) Johann Wolfgang von Goethe: German’s greatest literary figure; Hafiz (c. 1325-1389), Persian poet and theologian. [Back to Text] (8) Alcibiades: (450-404 BC), charismatic Athenian politician and general; Julius Caesar (100-44 BC), prominent Roman politician and general; Frederick II (1194-1250), Holy Roman Emperor of the Hohenstaufen dynasty, an extraordinarily gifted and powerful medieval figure; Leonardo da Vinci (1452-1519), an Italian painter, engineer, and inventor, one of the most amazing geniuses of the Renaissance. [Back to Text]

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=== Part 6: We Scholars

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=== Friedrich Nietzsche BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL Translated by Ian Johnston, Vancouver Island University, Nanaimo, British Columbia, Canada

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At the risk that moralizing here also shows itself to be what it always has been—that is, an unabashed *montrer ses plaies* [display of one’s wounds], as Balzac says—I’d like to dare to stand up against an unreasonable and harmful shift in rank ordering that nowadays, quite unnoticed and as if with the clearest conscience, threatens to establish itself between science and philosophy. I think that on the basis of our experience—experience means, as I see it, always bad experience?—we must have a right to discuss such a higher question of rank, so that we do not speak like blind people about colour or as women and artists do against science (“Oh, this nasty science!” their instinct and embarrassment sigh, “it always finds out what’s behind things”—). The declaration of independence of the scientific man, his emancipation from philosophy, is one of the subtler effects of the nature of and the trouble with democracy: today the self-glorification and self-exaltation of the scholar stand everywhere in full bloom and their finest spring—but that is still not intended to mean that in this case self-praise smells very nice. “Away with all masters!”—that’s what the instinct of the rabble wants here, too, and now that science has enjoyed its happiest success in pushing away theology, whose “handmaiden” it was for too long, it has the high spirits and stupidity to set about making laws for philosophy and to take its turn playing the “master” for once—what am I saying?—playing the philosopher. My memory—the memory of a scientific man, if you’ll permit me to say so!—is filled to bursting with the *naïveté* I have heard in arrogant remarks about philosophy and philosophers from young natural scientists and old doctors (not to mention from the most educated and most conceited of all scholars, the philologists and schoolmen, who are both of these thanks to their profession—). Sometimes it was a specialist and idler who in general instinctively resisted all synthetic tasks and capabilities; sometimes the industrious worker who had taken a whiff of the *otium* [leisure] and of the noble opulence within the spiritual household of the philosopher and, as he did so, felt himself restricted and diminished. Sometimes it was that colour blindness of the utilitarian man, who sees nothing in philosophy other than a series of refuted systems and an extravagant expense

from which no one “receives any benefit.” Sometimes fear of disguised mysticism and of an adjustment to the boundaries of knowledge sprang up; sometimes the contempt for particular philosophers, which had unwittingly been generalized into a contempt for philosophy. Finally, among young scholars I most frequently found behind the arrogant belittlement of philosophy the pernicious effect of a philosopher himself, a man whom they had, in fact, generally ceased to follow, but without escaping the spell of his value judgments dismissing other philosophers—something which brought about a collective irritation with all philosophy. (For example, Schopenhauer’s effect on the most modern Germany seems to me to be something like this: with his unintelligent anger against Hegel he created a situation in which the entire last generation of Germans broke away from their connection to German culture, and this culture, all things well considered, was a high point in and a prophetic refinement of the historical sense.(1) But Schopenhauer himself in this very matter was impoverished to the point of genius—unreceptive and un-German.) From a general point of view and broadly speaking, it may well have been, more than anything else, the human, all-too-human nature of the more recent philosophers themselves, in a word, their paltry spirit, which has most fundamentally damaged respect for philosophy and opened the gates to the instincts of the rabble. We should nonetheless acknowledge the extent to which the whole style of Heraclitus, Plato, Empedocles, and of whatever all those royal and splendid hermits of the spirit were called is absent from our modern world and how, given the sort of representatives of philosophy who nowadays, thanks to fashion, are just as much on top as at the bottom—in Germany, for example, the two lions of Berlin, the anarchist Eugen Dühring and the amalgamist Eduard von Hartmann—an honest man of science is entitled to feel that he is justifiably of a better sort, with a better descent. In particular, the sight of these mishmash philosophers who call themselves “reality philosophers” or “positivists” is capable of casting a dangerous mistrust into the soul of an ambitious young scholar: they are, in the best of cases, scholars and specialists themselves—that’s clear enough—they have been, in fact, collectively defeated and brought back under the rule of science.(2) At some time or other they wanted more from themselves, without having any right to this “more” and to its responsibilities—and now, in word and deed, they represent in a respectable, angry, vengeful way the lack of faith [den Unglauben] in the ruling task and masterfulness of philosophy. But finally—how could it be anything different? Science nowadays is in bloom, its face is filled with good conscience, while what all recent philosophy has gradually sunk to—this remnant of philosophy today—is busy generating suspicion and ill humour against itself, if not mockery and pity. Philosophy reduced to “theory of knowledge” is, in fact, nothing more than a tentative epochism [Epochistik] and a doctrine of abstinence: a philosophy which does not venture one step over the

threshold and painstakingly denies itself the right to enter—that is philosophy at death’s door, an end, an agony, something pitiful! How could such a philosophy—rule!(3) 205 To tell the truth, there are so many varied dangers for the development of a philosopher today that we may well doubt whether this fruit can, in general, still grow ripe. The scope and the tower-building of the sciences have grown into something monstrous, and with these the probability that the philosopher has already grown tired while he is still learning or lets himself stop somewhere and “specialize,” so that he no longer reaches his full height, that is, high enough for an overview, for looking round, for looking down. Or else he reaches that point too late, when his best time and power are already over, or have become damaged, coarsened, and degenerate, so that his glance, his comprehensive value judgment, means little any more. The very refinement of his intellectual conscience perhaps allows him to hesitate along the way and to delay. He is afraid of being seduced into being a dilettante, a millipede, something with a thousand antennae. He knows too well that a man who has lost respect for himself may no longer give orders as a man of knowledge, may no longer lead. At that point, he would have to be willing to become a great actor, a philosophical Cagliostro and spiritual Pied Piper, in short, a seducer. In the end it’s a question of taste, even if it were not a question of conscience. Moreover, by way of doubling once again the difficulty for the philosopher, it comes to this: he demands from himself a judgment, a Yes or No, not about the sciences but about life and the value of living—he learns with reluctance to believe that he has a right or even a duty to make this judgment and that must seek his own path to that right and that belief only through the most extensive—perhaps the most disturbing, the most destructive—experiences, often hesitating, doubting, and saying nothing. As a matter of fact, the masses have for a long time mistaken and misidentified the philosopher, whether with the man of science and ideal scholar, or with the religiously elevated, desensualized, “unworldly” enthusiast drunk on God. If we hear anyone at all praised nowadays on the ground that he lives “wisely” or “like a philosopher,” that means almost nothing other than “prudently and on the sidelines.” Wisdom: that seems to the rabble to be some kind of escape, a means and a trick to pull oneself well out of a nasty game. But the real philosopher—as we see it, my friends?—lives “unphilosophically” and “unwisely,” above all imprudently, and feels the burden and the duty of a hundred attempts and temptations of life—he always puts himself at risk. He plays the wicked game. . . . 206 In comparison with a genius, that is, with a being who either engenders or gives birth, taking both words in their highest sense—the scholar, the average scientific man, always has something of the old maid about him, for, like the old maid, he does not understand the two most valuable things men do. In fact, for both scholars and old maids we concede, as if by way of compensation, that they are respectable—in their cases we stress

respectability—and yet having to make this concession gives us the same sense of irritation. Let's look more closely: What is the scientific man? To begin with, a man who is not a noble type. He has the virtues of a man who is not distinguished, that is, a type of person who is not a ruler, not authoritative, and also not self-sufficient. He has diligence, a patient endorsement of his position and rank, equanimity about and moderation in his abilities and needs. He has an instinct for people like him and for what people like him require, for example, that bit of independence and green meadows without which there is no peace in work, that demand for honour and acknowledgement (which assumes, first and foremost, recognition and the ability to be recognized—), that sunshine of a good name, that constant stamp of approval of his value and his utility, which is necessary to overcome again and again the inner suspicion at the bottom of the hearts of all dependent men and herd animals. The scholar also has, as stands to reason, the illnesses and bad habits of a non-noble type: he is full of petty jealousy and has a lynx eye for what is base in those natures whose heights are impossible for him to reach. He is trusting, but only as an individual who lets himself go but does not let himself flow. Before a person who is like a great stream he just stands there all the colder and more enclosed—his eye is then like a smooth, reluctant lake in which there is no longer any ripple of delight or sympathy. The worst and most dangerous thing of which a scholar is capable he gets from his instinctive sense of the mediocrity of his type, of that Jesuitical mediocrity, which spontaneously works for the destruction of the uncommon man and seeks to break every arched bow or—even better!—to relax it. That is, to unbend it, with consideration, of course, naturally with a flattering hand—to unbend it with trusting sympathy: that is the essential art of Jesuitism, which has always understood how to introduce itself as a religion of pity.— 207 No matter how gratefully we may accommodate ourselves to the objective spirit—and who has never been sick to death of everything subjective and its damnable ipsissimosity [references to itself]!—we must ultimately also learn caution concerning this gratitude and stop the exaggeration with which in recent years we have celebrated the depersonalizing of the spirit, emptying the self from the spirit, as if that were the goal in itself, redemption and transfiguration.(4) That's what tends to happen, for example, in the pessimism school, which, for its part, has good reasons for awarding highest honour to “disinterested knowledge.” The objective man who no longer curses and grumbles like the pessimist, the ideal scholar, in whom the scientific instinct, after thousands of total and partial failures, all of a sudden comes into bloom and blossoms fully, is surely one of the most precious implements there are, but he belongs in the hands of someone more powerful. He is only a tool, we say. He is a mirror—he is no “end in himself.” The objective man is, in fact, a mirror: accustomed to submit before everything that wishes to be known, without any delight other than that available

in knowing and “mirroring back”—he waits until something comes along and then spreads himself out tenderly so that even light footsteps and the spiritual essences slipping past are not lost on his surface and skin. What is still left of his “person” seems to him accidental, often a matter of chance, even more often disruptive, so completely has he himself become a conduit and reflection for strange shapes and events. He reflects about “himself” with effort and is not infrequently wrong. He readily gets himself confused with others. He makes mistakes concerning his own needs, and it is only here that he is coarse and careless. Perhaps he gets anxious about his health or about the pettiness and stifling atmosphere of wife and friends or about the lack of companions and society—indeed, he forces himself to think about his anxieties: but it’s no use! His thoughts have already wandered off to some more general example, and tomorrow he knows as little as he knew yesterday about how he might be helped. He has lost seriousness for himself—as well as time. He is cheerful, not from any lack of needs, but from a lack of fingers and handles for his own needs. His habitual concessions concerning all things and all experiences, the sunny and uninhibited hospitality with which he accepts everything which runs into him, his kind of thoughtless good will and dangerous lack of concern about Yes and No—alas, there are enough cases where he must atone for these virtues of his!—and as a human being he generally becomes far too easily the *caput mortuum* [worthless residue] of these virtues. If people want love and hate from him—I mean love and hate the way God, women, and animals understand them—he’ll do what he can and give what he can. But we should not be amazed when it doesn’t amount to much—when he reveals himself in these very matters as inauthentic, fragile, questionable, and rotten. His love is forced, his hate artificial, more a *tour de force*, a tiny vanity and exaggeration. He is genuine only as long as he is permitted to be objective: only in his cheerful comprehensiveness [Totalismus] is he still “nature” and “natural.” His mirror soul, always smoothing itself out, no longer knows how to affirm or deny. He does not command, and he does not destroy. “*Je ne méprise presque rien*” [There is almost nothing I despise]—he says with Leibnitz: we should not fail to hear and underestimate that *presque* [almost]!(5) Moreover, he is no model human being. He does not go ahead of anyone or behind. He places himself in general too far away to have a reason to take sides between good and evil. When people confused him for such a long time with the philosopher, with the Caesar-like breeder and powerhouses [Gewaltmenschen] of culture, they held him in much too high honour and overlooked the most essential thing about him—he is an instrument, something of a slave, although certainly the most sublime form of slave, but in himself nothing—*presque rien* [almost nothing]! The objective man is an instrument, an expensive, easily damaged and blunted tool for measurement and an artful arrangement of mirrors, something we should take care of and respect.

But he is no goal, no way out or upward, no complementary human being in whom the rest of existence is justified, no conclusion—and even less a beginning, a procreation and first cause. He is nothing strong, powerful, self-assured, something that wants to be master. He is much rather merely a delicate, inflated, sensitive, and flexible pot for forms, which must first wait for some content and meaning or other, in order to “give itself a shape” consistent with it—usually a man without form and content, a “selfless” man. And thus also nothing for women, in parenthesi [in parenthesis].— 208 When a philosopher nowadays lets us know he is not a sceptic—I hope people have sensed this from the description of the objective spirit immediately above?—the whole world is unhappy to hear it. People look at him with some awe and would like to ask so much, to question . . . in fact, among timid listeners—and there are hordes of them today—from that point on he is considered dangerous. For them it is as if in his rejection of scepticism they heard coming from far away some evil threatening noise, as if a new explosive was being tested somewhere, spiritual dynamite, perhaps a newly discovered Russian nihilin, a pessimism *bonae voluntatis* [of good will], which does not merely say No and will No but—terrible to imagine!—acts No!(6) Against this form of “good will”—a will to a truly active denial of life—there is today, by general agreement, no better sleeping pill and sedative than scepticism, the peaceful, gentle, soporific poppy of scepticism, and even Hamlet is prescribed these days by contemporary doctors against the “spirit” and its underground rumblings. “Aren’t people’s ears all full enough already of wicked noises?” says the sceptic, as a friend of peace and quiet, almost as a sort of security police: “This subterranean No is terrifying! Be quiet at last, you pessimistic moles!” For the sceptic, this tender creature, is frightened all too easily. His conscience has been trained to twitch with every No, even with a hard, decisive Yes—to respond as if it had been bitten. Yes! And No!—that contradicts his morality. Conversely, he loves to celebrate his virtue with a noble abstinence, perhaps by saying with Montaigne, “What do I know?”(7) Or with Socrates, “I know that I know nothing.” Or “Here I do not trust myself. There is no door open to me here.” Or “Suppose the door was open, why go in right away?” Or “What use are all rash hypotheses? Not to make any hypotheses at all could easily be part of good taste. Must you be so keen immediately to straighten something crooked? Or to stop up every hole with some piece of oakum? Isn’t there time for that? Doesn’t time have time? O you devilish fellows, can’t you wait, even for a bit? What is unknown also has its attraction—the Sphinx is a Circe, too, and Circe also was a philosopher.”(8) In this way a sceptic consoles himself, and he certainly needs some consolation. For scepticism is the most spiritual expression of a certain multifaceted physiological condition which in everyday language is called weak nerves and infirmity. It occurs every time races or classes which have been separated from each other a

long time suddenly and decisively cross breed. In the new generation, which has inherited in its blood, as it were, different standards and values, everything is restlessness, disturbance, doubt, experiment; the best forces have an inhibiting effect; even the virtues do not allow each other to grow and become strong; the body and soul lack equilibrium, a centre of gravity, a perpendicular self-assurance. But what is most profoundly sick and degenerates in such mixtures is the will. These people no longer know the independence in decision making, the bold sense of pleasure in willing—they have doubts about the “freedom of the will,” even in their dreams. Our Europe today, the scene of an insanely sudden attempt at radical mixing of classes and consequently of races, is as a result sceptical in all heights and depths, sometimes with that flexible scepticism which leaps impatiently and greedily from one branch to another, sometimes gloomy, like a cloud overloaded with question marks, and often sick to death of its will! Paralysis of the will—where nowadays do we not find this cripple sitting! And often how well dressed! In such a seductive outfit! This illness has the most beautifully splendid and deceitful clothing. For example, most of what presents itself in the display windows today as “objectivity,” “the practice of science,” “l’art pour l’art” [art for art’s sake], “purely disinterested knowledge” is only dressed up scepticism and paralysis of the will—I’ll stand by this diagnosis of the European disease. The sickness of the will has spread unevenly across Europe. It appears in its greatest and most varied forms where the culture has already been indigenous for the longest time, and it disappears to the extent that the “barbarian” still—or again—achieves his rights under the baggy clothing of Western culture. Thus, in contemporary France, we can conclude as easily as we can grasp it in our hands that the will is most seriously ill, and France, which has always had a masterful skill in transforming even the fateful changes in its spirit into something attractive and seductive, truly displays its cultural dominance over Europe today as the school and exhibition hall for all the charms of scepticism. The power to will and, indeed, to desire a will that lasts a long time, is already somewhat stronger in Germany, and in the north of Germany even more so than in the middle, but it’s significantly stronger in England, Spain, and Corsica. In Germany it’s bound up with apathy, and in those other places with hard heads—to say nothing of Italy, which is too young to know yet what it wants and which first must demonstrate whether it can will.—But it’s strongest and most amazing in that immense empire in between, where Europe, so to speak, flows back into Asia, that is, in Russia. There the power to will has for a long time lain dormant and built up, there the will waits menacingly—uncertain whether, to borrow a favourite phrase of our physicists today, it will be discharged as a will to negate or a will to affirm. It may require more than wars in India and developments in Asia for Europe to be relieved of its greatest danger; it will require inner revolutions, too, the breaking up of the empire into

small bodies and, above all, the introduction of the parliamentary nonsense, along with every man's duty to read his newspaper at breakfast. I'm not saying this because it's what I want. The opposite would be closer to my heart—I mean such an increase in the Russian danger, that Europe would have to decide to become equally a threat, that is, it would have to acquire a will, by means of a new caste which would rule Europe, a long, fearful, individual will, which could set itself goals for thousands of years from now—so that finally the long spun-out comedy of its small states, together with its multiple dynastic and democratic wills, would come to an end. The time for petty politics is over. The next century is already bringing on the battle for the mastery of the earth—the compulsion to grand politics. 209 The extent to which the new warlike age into which we Europeans have evidently entered may perhaps also be favourable to the development of another and stronger variety of scepticism—on that point I'd like to state my views only provisionally through a parable which friends of German history will understand easily enough. That harmless enthusiast for good-looking, tall grenadiers, who, as King of Prussia, brought into being a military and sceptical genius—and in the process basically created that new type of German who has just recently emerged victorious—the questionable and mad father of Frederick the Great—in one respect himself had the grip and lucky claw of genius.(9) He knew what Germany then needed, a lack which was a hundred times more worrisome and more urgent than some deficiency in culture and social style. His aversion to the young Frederick emerged from the anxiety of a profound instinct. What was missing was men. And he suspected to his most bitter annoyance that his own son might not be man enough. On that point he was deceived, but who in his place would not have been deceived? He saw his son decline into atheism, esprit, the pleasure-loving frivolousness of witty Frenchmen:—he saw in the background the great blood sucker, the spider of scepticism. He suspected the incurable misery of a heart that is no longer hard enough for evil and for good, of a fractured will that no longer commands, is no longer capable of commanding. But in the meantime there grew up in his son that more dangerous and harder new form of scepticism—who knows how much it was encouraged by that very hatred of his father's and by the icy melancholy of a will pushed into solitude?—the scepticism of daring masculinity, which is most closely related to the genius for war and conquest and which, in the shape of Frederick the Great, first gained entry into Germany. This scepticism despises and nonetheless grabs hold. It undermines and takes possession. It does not believe, but in so doing does not lose itself. It gives the spirit a dangerous freedom, but it keeps a firm grip on the heart. It is the German form of scepticism, which, as a constant Frederickianism [Fridericianismus] intensified into the highest spirituality, has brought Europe for some time under the dominion of the German spirit and its critical and historical mistrust. Thanks to

the invincibly strong and tenacious masculine character of the great German philologists and historical critics (who, if we see them properly, were collectively also artists of destruction and subversion), gradually anew idea of the German spirit established itself, in spite of all the Romanticism in music and philosophy, an idea in which the characteristic of manly scepticism stepped decisively forward: it could be, for example, a fearlessness in the gaze, courage and hardness in the dissecting hand, a tough will for dangerous voyages of discovery, for expeditions to the spiritual North Pole under bleak and dangerous skies. There may well be good reasons why warm-blooded and superficial humanitarians cross themselves when confronted with this particular spirit: Michelet, not without a shudder, calls it *cet esprit fataliste, ironique, méphistophélique* [this fatalistic and ironic Mephistophelean spirit].(10) But if we want to sense how distinctive this fear of the “man” in the German spirit is, through which Europe was roused out of its “dogmatic slumber,” we might remember the earlier idea which it had to overthrow—and how it is still not so long ago that a masculine woman could dare, with unrestrained presumption, to recommend the Germans to the sympathy of Europe as gentle, good-hearted, weak-willed, poetical idiots.(11) Finally, we should understand with sufficient profundity Napoleon’s surprise when he happened to see Goethe: that reveals what people had thought about the “German spirit” for centuries. “Voilà un homme!” [There is a man!]²¹⁰—which is, in effect, saying: “That is really a man! And I had expected only a German!”— Assuming, then, that in the image of the philosophers of the future there is some characteristic which raises the question whether they would not perhaps have to be sceptics, in the sense indicated immediately above, that would, nonetheless, indicate only one thing about them—and not what they themselves were. With just as much justification they could let themselves be called critics, and it’s certain they will be people who experiment. In the names with which I have ventured to christen them, I have already particularly emphasized experiments and their enjoyment in attempting experiments. Did I do this because, as critics in body and soul, they love to use experiments in a new, perhaps broader, perhaps more dangerous sense? In their passion for knowledge, will they have to go further with daring and painful experiments, than could be considered appropriate by the soft-hearted and mollicoddled taste of a democratic century? There is no doubt that these coming philosophers will be least of all able to rid themselves of those serious and not unobjectionable characteristics which separate the critic from the sceptic—I mean the certainty in the measure of value, the conscious use of a unity of method, the shrewd courage, the standing alone, and the ability to answer for themselves. In fact, they confess that they take delight in saying No and in dissecting things and in a certain thought-out cruelty, which knows how to guide the knife surely and precisely, even when the heart is

still bleeding. They will be harder (and perhaps not always only on themselves) than humane people might wish; they will not get involved with the “truth,” so that the truth can “please” them or “elevate” them and “inspire” them:—by contrast, they will have little faith that the truth itself brings with it such emotional entertainment. They will smile, these strict spirits, if someone should declare in front of them, “That idea elevates me: how could it not be true?” or “That work delights me: how could it not be beautiful?” or, “That artist enlarges me; how could he not be great?”—Perhaps they are prepared not only to smile at but also to feel a genuine disgust for everything equally enthusiastic, idealistic, feminine and hermaphroditic. Anyone who knew how to follow them right into the secret chambers of their hearts would hardly find there any intention to reconcile “Christian feelings” with “the taste of antiquity” or even with “modern parliamentarianism” (a reconciliation which is said to be taking place even among philosophers in our very uncertain and therefore very conciliatory century). These philosophers of the future will demand not only of themselves critical discipline and every habit which leads to purity and strictness in things of the spirit: they could show them off as their own kind of jewellery—nonetheless, for all that they still do not wish to be called critics. It seems to them no small insult inflicted on philosophy when people decree, as they are so fond of doing today, “Philosophy itself is criticism and critical science—and nothing else!” This evaluation of philosophy may enjoy the applause of all French and German positivists (—and it’s possible that it would have flattered even the heart and taste of Kant: we should remember the title of his major works—): our new philosophers will nonetheless affirm that critics are the tools of the philosopher and for that very reason, the fact that they are tools, are still a long way from being philosophers themselves! Even the great Chinaman of Königsberg [Kant] was only a great critic. 211 I insist on the following point: people should finally stop confusing philosophical labourers and scientific people in general with philosophers—in this particular matter we should strictly assign “to each his due” and not give too much to the former and much too little to the latter. It may be that the education of a real philosopher requires that he himself has once stood on all of those steps where his servants, the scientific labourers in philosophy, remain—and must remain. Perhaps he must himself have been critic and sceptic and dogmatist and historian and, in addition, poet and collector and traveller and solver of riddles and moralist and prophet and “free spirit” and almost everything, in order to move through the range of human worth and feelings of value and to be able to look with a variety of different eyes and consciences from the heights into every distance, from the depths into every height, from the corners into every expanse. But all these things are only preconditions for his task: the task itself requires something different—it demands that he create values. Those philosophical labourers on the noble model of Kant and Hegel

have to establish some large collection of facts concerning estimates of value—that is, earlier statements of value, creations of value that have become dominant and for a while have been called “truths”—and press them into formulas, whether in the realm of logic or politics (morality) or art. The task of these researchers is to make everything that has happened and which has been valued up to now clear, easy to imagine, intelligible, and manageable, to shorten everything lengthy, even “time” itself, and to overpower the entire past, a huge and marvellous task, in the service of which every sophisticated pride and every tough will can certainly find satisfaction. But the real philosophers are commanders and lawgivers: they say “That is how it should be!” They determine first the “Where to?” and the “What for?” of human beings, and, as they do this, they have at their disposal the preliminary work of all philosophical labourers, all those who have overpowered the past—they reach with their creative hands to grasp the future. In that process, everything that is and has been becomes a means for them, an instrument, a hammer. Their “knowing” is creating; their creating is establishing laws; their will to truth is—will to power.—Are there such philosophers nowadays? Have there ever been such philosophers? Is it not necessary that there be such philosophers? . . . 212 It is increasingly apparent to me that the philosopher, who is necessarily a man of tomorrow and the day after, has in every age found and had to find himself in contradiction to his today: his enemy every time was the ideal of the day. Up to now all these extraordinary promoters of humanity whom we call philosophers and who themselves seldom felt that they were friends of wisdom but rather embarrassing fools and dangerous question marks, have discovered that their work, their hard, unsought for, inescapable task—but finally the greatness of their work—was for them to be the bad conscience of their age. By applying the knife of vivisection directly on the chest of the virtues of the day, they revealed what their own secret was—to know a new greatness for man, to know a new untrodden path to increasing his greatness. Every time they exposed how much hypocrisy, laziness, letting oneself go, and letting oneself fall, how many lies lay hidden under the most highly honoured type of their contemporary morality, how much virtue was out of date; every time they said, “We must go there, out there, where you nowadays are least at home.” Faced with a world of “modern ideas” that would like to banish everyone into a corner and a “specialty,” a philosopher, if there could be a philosopher these days, would be compelled to establish the greatness of mankind, the idea of “greatness,” directly on the basis of man’s range and multiplicity, of his integrated totality in the midst of diversity. He would even determine value and rank according to how much and how many different things one person could endure and take upon himself, how far he could extend his own responsibility. Today contemporary taste and virtue weaken and dilute the will; nothing is as topical as the weakness of the will. Thus, in the ideal

of the philosopher it is precisely the strength of will, hardness, and the ability to make lengthy decisions that must be part of the idea “greatness”—with just as much justification as the opposite doctrine and the ideal of a stupid, denying, humble, selfless humanity was appropriate to an opposite age, one which suffered, like the sixteenth century, from the bottled-up energy of its will and from the wildest torrents and storm tides of selfishness. At the time of Socrates, among nothing but men of exhausted instincts, among conservative old Athenians, who allowed themselves to go “for happiness,” as they said, and for pleasure, as they did, and who, in the process, still kept mouthing the old splendid words to which their lives no longer gave them any right, perhaps irony was essential for greatness in the soul, that malicious Socratic confidence of the old doctor and member of the rabble, who sliced ruthlessly into his own flesh, as into the flesh and heart of the “noble man,” with a look which spoke intelligibly enough “Don’t play act in front of me! Here—we are the same!” By contrast, today, when the herd animal in Europe is the only one who attains and distributes honours, when “equality of rights” all too easily could get turned around into equality of wrongs—what I mean is into a common war against everything rare, strange, privileged, the higher man, the higher soul, the higher duty, the higher responsibility, the creative fullness of power and mastery—these days the sense of being noble, of willing to be for oneself, of being able to be different, of standing alone, and of having to live by one’s own initiative—these are part of the idea “greatness,” and the philosopher will reveal something of his own ideal if he proposes “The man who is to be the greatest is the one who can be the most solitary, the most hidden, the most deviant, the man beyond good and evil, lord of his virtues, a man lavishly endowed with will—this is precisely what (T)greatness(T) is to be called: capable of being as much an integrated totality as he is something multifaceted, as wide as he is full.” And to ask the question again: today—is greatness possible? 213 What a philosopher is, that’s difficult to learn because it cannot be taught: one must “know” it out of experience—or one should have the pride not to know it. But the fact that these days the whole world talks of things about which it cannot have any experience holds true above all and in the worst way for philosophers and philosophical situations: very few people are acquainted with them and are allowed to know them, and all popular opinions about them are false. And so, for example, that genuine philosophical association of a bold, exuberant spirituality, which speeds along presto, with a dialectical strictness and necessity which takes no false steps is unknown to most thinkers and scholars from their own experience, and hence, if someone wishes to talk about it in front of them, they find it implausible. They take the view that every necessity is an affliction, a painful requirement they must follow, a compulsion, and thinking itself they consider something slow, hesitant, almost laborious, and often enough “worth the sweat of the noble”—but

under no circumstances something light, divine, closely related to dancing and high spirits! “Thinking” and “taking an issue seriously,” “considering it gravely”—among them these belong together: that’s the only way they have “experienced” thinking. In such matters artists may have a more subtle sense of smell. They know only too well that at the very moment when they no longer create “voluntarily,” when they make everything by necessity, their sense of freedom, refinement, authority, of creative setting up, disposing, and shaping is at its height—in short, that necessity and the “freedom of the will” are then one thing for them. Ultimately there is a rank ordering of spiritual conditions, with which the rank ordering of problems is consistent, and the highest problems shove back without mercy anyone who dares approach them without having been predestined to solve them with the loftiness and power of his spirituality. What help is it if nimble heads of nondescript people or, as happens so often these days, clumsy honest mechanics and empiricists with their plebeian ambition press forward into the presence of such problems and, as it were, up to the “court of courts”? But on such carpets crude feet may never tread: there is still a primeval law of things to look after that: the doors remain closed to these people who push against them, even if they bang or crush their heads against them! One must be born for every lofty world: to put the matter more clearly, one must be cultivated for it: one has a right to philosophy—taking the word in its grand sense—only thanks to one’s descent, one’s ancestors; here, as well, “blood” decides. For a philosopher to arise, many generations must have done the preparatory work. Every single one of his virtues must have been acquired, cared for, passed on, assimilated, and not just the bold, light, delicate walking and running of his thoughts, but, above all, the willingness to take on great responsibilities, the loftiness of the look which dominates and gazes down, the feeling of standing apart from the crowd and its duties and virtues, the affable protecting and defending of what is misunderstood and slandered, whether god or devil, the desire for and practice of great justice, the art of commanding, the breadth of will, the slow eye that seldom admires, seldom looks upward, seldom loves. . . .

NOTES (1) Georg Wilhelm Friedrich Hegel (1770-1831), important German idealist philosopher. [Back to Text] (2) Eugen Dühring (1833-1921) and Eduard von Hartmann (1842-1906): two well-known philosophers in Nietzsche’s day. [Back to Text] (3) Epochism means dividing time or history up into epochs. [Back to Text] (4) Nietzsche coined the word *Ipsissimosität* from the Latin *ipsissima* meaning very own. [Back to Text] (5) Gottfried Wilhelm Leibnitz (1646-1716), German philosopher, diplomat, and mathematician. [Back to Text] (6) nihilin: a word Nietzsche invents to designate some new form of strong pessimism discovered like some as yet unknown chemical. [Back to Text] (7) Michel de Montaigne (1533-1592), French diplomat and writer. [Back to Text] (8) Circe: a goddess in Homer’s *Odyssey* who has magical powers to turn men

into swine. [Back to Text]] (9) Frederick the Great (1712-1786), son of Frederick William I, King of Prussia. Through his military and political skill he greatly enlarged Prussian territory. [Back to Text] (10) Jules Michelet (1798-1874), a French historian. Mephistopheles is the chief agent of the Devil in Goethe's Faust. [Back to Text] (11) The woman is Madame de Staël, a French writer who produced a book about German and the Germans in 1810. [Back to Text]

==== Part 7: Our Virtues

==== Friedrich Nietzsche BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL Translated by Ian Johnston, Vancouver Island University, Nanaimo, British Columbia, Canada
Students, teachers, artists, and members of the general public may download and distribute this text without permission and without charge. They may also freely edit the text for their own purposes. All commercial use of this translation, however, is forbidden without the permission of the translator. For comments and questions, please contact Ian Johnston. For a Rich Text Version (Word) of this text, please use the following link: [Beyond Good and Evil \[RTF\]](#) [Table of Contents for Beyond Good and Evil] PART SEVEN OUR VIRTUES 214 Our virtues? It's probable that we, too, still have our virtues, although it's reasonable to think that they will not be those naive, four-square virtues for whose sake we respect our grandfathers, at the same time holding them somewhat at arm's length. We Europeans of the day-after-tomorrow, we first-born of the twentieth century—with all our dangerous curiosity, our multiplicity and art of disguise, our tender and, so to speak, sweetened cruelty in spirit and sense—if we're to have virtues, we'll presumably have only those which have learned best how to tolerate our most secret and most heartfelt inclinations, our most burning needs. So then let's look for them in our labyrinths!—where, as we know, so many different things get lost, so many different things disappear forever. And is there anything more beautiful than seeking out one's own virtues? Doesn't this already almost mean that one believes in one's own virtues? But this phrase "believe in one's own virtues"—isn't that basically the same thing people in earlier times used to call their "good conscience," that long worthy pigtail of an idea which our grandfathers hung behind their heads and often enough behind their understanding as well? Thus, it seems to follow that, no matter how little we may think of ourselves as old fashioned and as respectable as our grandfathers in other things, in one respect we are nonetheless the worthy grandsons of these grandfathers, we last Europeans with good consciences: we, too, still carry their pigtail.—Alas, if you knew how soon, how very soon—things will be otherwise! . . . 215 Just as it sometimes happens in the realm of the stars that two suns determine the orbit of a planet, and in some cases suns of different colours

cast their lights around a single planet, sometimes red light, sometimes green light, and then again lighting it both at once, flooding it with many colours, in the same way we modern men, thanks to the complicated mechanics of our “starry heaven,” are determined by different moralities; our actions change their lights into different colours. They are rarely unambiguous—and there are enough cases where we carry out actions with many colours. 216 Love one’s enemies? I think that has been well learned. These days it happens thousands of times, in small and big things. In fact, now and then something even higher and more sublime takes place—we learn to despise when we love, and precisely when we love best: but all this is unconscious, without any fuss, without any pomp and circumstance, rather with that modesty and secret goodness which prohibit solemn words and virtuous formulas. Morality as a pose—that offends our taste nowadays. This is also a step forward, just as it was a step forward for our fathers when religion as a pose finally offended their taste, including hostility to and a Voltairean bitterness against religion (and everything that formerly went along with the sign language of free thinkers). It’s the music in our conscience, the dance in our spirit, that makes all puritanical litanies, all moral sermons and petty bourgeois respectability sound out of tune. 217 Be careful of those who set a high value on people’s ascribing to them moral tact and refinement in drawing moral distinctions! They never forgive us if they ever make a mistake in front of us (or even against us)—inevitably they become people who instinctively slander and damage us, even when they still remain our “friends.”—Blessed are the forgetful, for they are “done” with their stupidities as well. 218 Psychologists in France—and where else nowadays are there still any psychologists?—have not yet stopped enjoying the bitter and manifold pleasure they get from *bêtise* *bourgoise* [bourgeois stupidity]. It’s as if—but enough, by doing that they are revealing something. For example, Flaubert, that worthy citizen of Rouen, finished up by seeing, hearing, and tasting nothing else any more.(1) That was his kind of self-torture and more refined cruelty. Now, for a change—since this is becoming tedious—I recommend something else for our delight, and that is the unconscious shiftiness with which all good, thick, well-behaved, average spirits react to higher spirits and the work they do, that subtle, barbed, Jesuitical shiftiness, which is a thousand times more subtle than the understanding and taste of these middle-class people in their best moments—or even than the understanding of their victims as well. This is repeated evidence for the fact that “instinct” is the most intelligent of all forms of intelligence discovered so far. Briefly put, you psychologists should study the philosophy of the “rule” in its war against the “exception.” There you’ll see a drama good enough for the gods and divine maliciousness! Or, to put the matter still more clearly: practise vivisection on the “good person,” on the “*homo bonae voluntatis*” [man of good will]. . . on yourselves! 219 Moral judgment and condemnation are the favourite

revenge of the spiritually limited against those who are less limited, as well as a form of compensation for the fact that nature has thought ill of them, and finally a chance to acquire some spirit and become refined:—malice spiritualizes. Deep in their hearts they feel good that there is a standard before which those plentifully endowed with spiritual wealth and privilege also stand, just like them:—they fight for the “equality of all before God” and almost require a faith in God just for that purpose. Among them are the most powerful opponents of atheism. Anyone who said to them “A high spirituality cannot be compared with any of the solidity and respectability of a man who is merely moral” would make them furious:—I’ll be careful not to do this. I’d much prefer to flatter them with my theory that a high spirituality itself arises only as the final offspring of moral qualities, that it is a synthesis of all those states which are ascribed to the “merely moral” man, after they have been acquired one by one through long discipline and practice, perhaps through an entire chain of generations, that high spirituality is simply the spiritualization of justice and of that kind severity which knows that its task is to maintain the order of rank in the world, not only among human beings, but even among things. 220 Given the present popular praise of the “disinterested person,” we must bring to mind, perhaps not without a certain danger, what it is that really interests the populace, and what, in general, are those things about which the common man is fundamentally and deeply concerned, including educated people, even scholars, and, unless all appearances deceive, perhaps philosophers as well. From that fact it turns out that the vast majority of what interests and charms more refined and more discriminating tastes and every higher nature appears completely “uninteresting” to the average man. Nonetheless, when he notices a devotion to these things, he calls it “*désintéressé*” [disinterested] and wonders to himself how it is possible to act “without interest.” There have been philosophers who have known how to confer a seductive and mystically transcendental form of expression upon this popular wonder (perhaps because in their own experience they knew nothing of higher nature?)—instead of presenting what’s reasonable—the honest naked truth that the “disinterested” action is a very interesting and interested action, provided . . . “And love?”—What’s that! Is even an action done from love supposed to be “unegoistic”? You idiots—! “What about the praise for the person who makes a sacrifice?”—But anyone who has really made a sacrifice knows that he wanted and got something for it—perhaps something of himself in exchange for something of himself—he gave up here in order to have more there, perhaps in general to be more or at least to feel himself as “more.” But this is a realm of questions and answers in which a more discriminating spirit does not like to remain; here even truth finds it so very necessary to suppress her yawns when she is required to give an answer. In the last analysis, truth is a woman: we should not treat her with force. 221 It so happens, said a moralistic pedant

and pettifogger, that I respect and honour a selfless man, not because he is unselfish but because he seems to me to have a right to be of use to another man at his own expense. All right, but it's always a question of who he is and who the other is. For example, in a man who is marked out and made for command, self-denial and modest holding back would not be a virtue but a waste of virtue: that's what it seems like to me. Every unegoistic morality which takes itself unconditionally and applies itself to everyone not only sins against taste; it also provokes sins of omission, one more seduction under the guise of philanthropy—and, in particular, a seduction for and injury to the higher, rarer, and privileged people. We must compel moralities first and foremost to give way before the order of rank. We must force into the conscience of moralities an awareness of their own presumption—until they finally are collectively clear about the fact that it is immoral to say “What is right for one man is fair to another.” As for my moralistic pedant and *bonhomme* [fine fellow]: does he deserve it when people laugh at him as he advises moralities in this way to become moral? But people should not be too much in the right if they want those who laugh on their side. A small grain of wrong is even a part of good taste. 222 Nowadays wherever people preach pity—and, if one listens correctly, there is now no other religion preached anymore—the psychologist should keep his ears open: through all the vanity, through all the noise characteristic of these preachers (like all preachers), he'll hear a hoarse, moaning, genuine sound of self-contempt. It's part of that process of making Europe dark and ugly, which has been growing now for a hundred years (and whose first symptoms were already placed in the documentary record in a thoughtful letter from Galiani to Madame d'Épinay): unless it's the cause of this development!(2) The man of “modern ideas,” that proud ape, is uncontrollably dissatisfied with himself—that's established. He's suffering, and his vanity wants him only to suffer “with others” . . . 223 At any rate, the hybrid European—a reasonably ugly plebeian, all in all—needs a costume. He needs history as a storeroom of costumes. Naturally, he then notices that none of them fits his body properly—he changes and changes. Just take a look at the nineteenth century, at the rapid preferences and changes in the masquerades of style, along with the moments of despair over the fact that “nothing suits” us—. It's no use presenting oneself romantically or classically or in a Christian or Florentine or Baroque or “national” manner in *moribus et artibus* [in customs and the arts]—it “doesn't suit us”! But the “spirit,” in particular the “historical spirit,” also sees an advantage for itself even in this despair: over and over again a new piece of the past and of a foreign place is tested, put on, set aside, packed away, and above all studied:—we are the first age studious about the issue of “costume”: I mean in moralities, articles of faith, tastes in art, and religions, prepared as no other time ever was for a carnival in the grand style, for the most spiritual revelry of laughter and high spirits, for a

transcendental height of the loftiest nonsense and Aristophanic mockery of the world.(3) Perhaps this is the very place where we are still discovering the realm of our own inventiveness, that realm where we too can still be original as some sort of satirists of world history and God's clowns—perhaps when nothing else today has a future, perhaps it's our very laughter that still has one! 224

The historical sense (or the ability to make quick conjectures about the rank ordering of value judgments according to which a people, a society, or a person has lived, the “instinct for divination” concerning the relations among these value judgments, for the connections between the authority of values and the authority of forces at work)—this historical sense which we Europeans claim as our distinctive characteristic, came to us as a consequence of the enthralling and wild semi-barbarianism into which Europe was plunged through the democratic intermixing of the classes and races—only the nineteenth century knows this sense as its sixth sense. The past of every form and manner of living, of cultures which earlier lay right alongside each other or over each other, flows, thanks to this intermixing, out into us “modern souls”; our instincts now run back all over the place; we ourselves are a kind of chaos. Finally “the spirit,” as I have said, sees an advantage for itself in this. Because of our semi-barbarism in body and desires we have secret entrances in all directions, in a way no noble age ever possessed, above all entrances to the labyrinth of unfinished cultures and to every semi-barbarism that has ever been present on earth. Inasmuch as the most considerable part of human civilization up to now has been semi-barbarism, the “historical sense” almost means the sense and instinct for everything, the taste and tongue for everything. And that establishes right away that it's an ignoble sense. For example, we enjoy Homer again. It's perhaps our happiest advance that we understand how to appreciate Homer, something which men of a noble culture do not know and did not know how to appropriate so easily and which they hardly allowed themselves to enjoy (for example, the French of the seventeenth century, like Saint Evremond, who criticized him for his *esprit vaste* [vast and all-encompassing spirit], and even Voltaire, their final chorus).(4) That very emphatic Yes and No of their palate, their easily aroused disgust, their hesitant holding back with respect to everything strange, their fear of bad taste, even of lively curiosity, and, in general, that reluctance of every noble and self-satisfied culture to acknowledge a new desire, a dissatisfaction with what is its own, an admiration for something foreign; all this makes them hostile even to the best things of the world which are not their own property or could not become their plunder—and no sense is more incomprehensible to such people than the historical sense and its obsequious plebeian curiosity. The situation is no different with Shakespeare, that amazing Spanish-Moorish-Saxon synthesis of taste, who would have made an old Athenian, one of Aeschylus' friends, laugh himself almost to death or irritated him. But we take up this wild

display of colours, this confusion of the most delicate, coarsest, and most artificial things with a secret confidence and good will. We enjoy him as the very refinement of art saved especially for us and, in the process, do not allow ourselves to be disturbed at all by the unpleasant stink and the proximity of the English rabble, in which Shakespeare's art and taste live, no more so than on the Chiaja in Naples, where we go on our way with all our senses enchanted and keen, no matter how much the sewers of the rabble's quarter fill the air.⁽⁵⁾ We men of the "historical sense," we have our corresponding virtues. That's beyond dispute. We are undemanding, unselfish, modest, brave, full of self-control, full of devotion, very grateful, very patient, very obliging:—with all that we are perhaps not very "tasteful." Let's finally admit it to ourselves: what's hardest for us men of "historical sense" to grasp, to feel, to taste, and to love, what we're basically prejudiced against and almost hostile to is precisely the perfection and ultimate maturity in every culture and art, what is really noble in works or in men, the moment when their sea is smooth and they have halcyon self-sufficiency, the gold and the coolness displayed by all things that have perfected themselves. Perhaps the great virtue of the historical sense stands in a necessary opposition to good taste, at least to the very best taste, and we can reproduce in ourselves only with difficulty and hesitantly, only by forcing ourselves, the small, short, and highest strokes of happiness and transfigurations of human life, as they suddenly shine out here and there: those moments and miracles where a great force voluntarily remains standing before the boundless and unlimited—where an excess of sophisticated pleasure was enjoyed in sudden restraint and petrification, in standing firm and holding oneself steady on still trembling ground. Restraint is strange to us. Let's admit that to ourselves. Our itch is the particular itch for the unlimited, the unmeasured. Like the rider on a steed snorting its way forward we let the reins fall before the infinite, we modern men, we half-barbarians—and reach our bliss only in a place where we are most—in danger. 225 Whether hedonism, pessimism, utilitarianism, or eudaimonism—all these ways of thinking which measure the value of things according to pleasure and pain, that is, according to attendant circumstances and secondary issues, are ways of thinking in the foreground and naiveté, which anyone who knows about creative forces and an artistic conscience will look down on, not without ridicule and not without pity. Pity for you!—that is, of course, not pity the way you mean the term: not pity for social "distress," for "society" and its sick and unsuccessful people, for those depraved and broken down from the start—they're lying on the ground all around us—even less is it pity for the grumbling oppressed, the rebellious slave classes, who strive for mastery—they call it "Freedom." Our pity is a higher compassion which sees further—we see how man is making himself smaller, how you are making him smaller!—and there are moments when we look at your very pity with an indescribable anxiety,

when we defend ourselves against this pity—when we find your seriousness more dangerous than any carelessness. You want, if possible—and there is no more fantastic “if possible”—to do away with suffering. What about us? It does seem that we would prefer it to be even greater and worse than it ever was! Wellbeing, the way you understand it—that is no goal. To us that looks like an end, a condition which immediately makes human beings laughable and contemptible—something which makes their destruction desirable! The discipline of suffering, of great suffering—do you not realize that up to this point it is only this discipline that has created every enhancement in man up to now? That tension of a soul in misery which develops its strength, its trembling when confronted with great destruction, its inventiveness and courage in bearing, holding out against, interpreting, and using misfortune, and whatever has been conferred upon it by way of profundity, secrecy, masks, spirit, cunning, and greatness—has that not been given to it through suffering, through the discipline of great suffering? In human beings, creature and creator are united. In man is material stuff, fragments, excess, clay, mud, folly, and chaos, but in man there is also creator, artist, hammer hardness, the divinity of the spectator and the seventh day—do you understand this contrast? And do you understand that your pity for the “creature in man” is for what must be formed, broken, forged, torn apart, burned, annealed, and purified—for what must necessarily suffer and should suffer? And our pity—do you not understand for whom our reverse pity matters, when it protects itself against your pity as against the most wretched of all mollycoddling and weakness?—And so pity against pity!—But, to say the point again, there are higher problems than all those of enjoyment, suffering, and pity, and every philosophy that leads only to these is something naive.— 226 We immoral ones!—This world which we are concerned with, in which we have to fear and love, this almost invisible and inaudible world of sophisticated commanding and sophisticated obeying, a world of “almost” from every way of looking at it—entangled, insidious, cutting, and tender—yes, this world is well defended against clumsy spectators and familiar curiosity! We have been woven into a strict yarn and shirt of duties and cannot get out of it—in that respect we are simply “men of duty,” we as well! Now and then, it’s true, we dance in our “chains” and between our “swords.” More often, it’s no less true, we gnash our teeth about it and are impatient with all the secret hardness of our fate. But we can do what we like: the fools and appearance speak against us: “They are men without duty.”—We always have fools and appearance against us! 227 If we assume that honesty is a virtue of ours from which we cannot escape, we free spirits—well, we’ll want to work on it with all our malice and love and not grow tired of “making ourselves perfect” in our virtue, the only one which remains ours: may its brilliance one day remain lying like a gilded, blue, mocking evening light over this aging culture and its dull and dark seriousness! And if

nonetheless our honesty one day grows tired and sighs and stretches its limbs and finds us too hard and would like to have things better, lighter, more loving, like a pleasing vice, let us remain hard, we final Stoics! And let us send her by way of help only what we have in us of devilry—our disgust with what is crude and approximate, our “nitimur in vetitum” [we seek what is forbidden], our courage as adventurers, our shrewd and discriminating curiosity, our most refined, most disguised, and most spiritual will to power and overcoming of the world which roams and swarms greedily around all realms of the future—let us come to the aid of our “god” with all our “devils”! It is likely that because of this people fail to recognize us and get us confused with others. What does that matter? People will say “Their ‘honesty’—that’s their devilry, nothing more than that.” What does that matter? Even if they were right! Haven’t all gods up to now been like that, devils who became holy by being re-christened? And what finally do we know about ourselves? And that spirit which guides us, what does it want to be called (it is a matter of names)? And how many spirits are we hiding? Our honesty, we free spirits—let’s take care that it does not become our vanity, our finery and splendour, our limit, our stupidity! Every virtue tends towards stupidity; every stupidity tends towards virtue: “stupid all the way to holiness” people say in Russia—let’s take care that we don’t end up becoming saints and bores through honesty! Isn’t life a hundred times too short to get bored with it? We would already have to believe in eternal life, in order to . . . 228 I hope people forgive me the discovery that all moral philosophy so far has been boring and has belonged among things which send us to sleep—and that, in my eyes, “virtue” has been impaired by nothing so much as by this tediousness of its advocates. In saying this I still don’t wish to deny their general utility. A great deal rests on the fact that as few people as possible think about morality—and so it’s very important that morality does not one day become interesting! But that’s not something people should worry about! These days things still stand the way they always have stood: I do not see anyone in Europe who might have (or might provide) some idea about how reflecting on morality could be conducted dangerously, insidiously, and seductively—that there could be disaster in the process. People should consider, for example, the tireless unavoidable English utilitarians, how they wander around crudely and honourably in Bentham’s footsteps, moving this way and that (a Homeric metaphor says it more clearly), just as Bentham himself had already wandered in the footsteps of the honourable Helvetius (this Helvetius—no, he was no dangerous man!).(6) No new idea, nothing of a more refined expression and bending of an old idea, not even a real history of an earlier thought: an impossible literature in its totality, unless we understand how to spice it up with some malice. For in these moralists as well (whom we really have to read with their ulterior motives in mind [mit Nebengedanken], if we have to read them—) that old English vice called cant

and moral Tartufferie [hypocrisy], has inserted itself, this time hidden under a new form of scientific thinking. Nor is there any lack of a secret resistance against the pangs of conscience, something a race of former Puritans will justifiably suffer from in all its scientific preoccupations with morality. (Isn't a moralist the opposite of a Puritan, namely, a thinker who considers morality something questionable, worth raising questions about, in short, as a problem? Shouldn't moralizing be—immoral?). In the end they all want English morality to be considered right, so that then mankind or "general needs" or "the happiness of the greatest number"—no! England's happiness—will be best served. They want to prove with all their might that striving for English happiness, I mean for comfort and fashion (and, as the highest priority, a seat in Parliament) is at the same time also the right path of virtue, in fact, that all virtue which has existed in the world so far has consisted of just such striving. Not one of all those ponderous herd animals with uneasy consciences (who commit themselves to promoting the cause of egoism as an issue of general welfare—) wants to know or catch a whiff of the fact that the "general welfare" is no ideal, no goal, not even a concept one can somehow grasp, but is only an emetic—that what is right for one man cannot in any way therefore be right for another, that the demand for a single morality for everyone is a direct restriction on the higher men, in short, that there is a rank ordering between man and man, as a result, also between morality and morality. These utilitarian Englishmen are a modest and thoroughly mediocre kind of human being and, as mentioned, insofar as they are boring, we cannot think highly enough of their utility. We should even encourage them, just as, to some extent, someone has tried to do in the following rhyme: Hail to you, brave working lout, "It's always better when drawn out." Always stiff in head and knee Never funny, never keen, Always sticking to the mean— Sans genie et sans esprit.(7) 229 In these recent ages, which may be proud of their humanity, there remains so much fear, so much superstitious(T) fear of the "wild cruel beasts," animals which these more humane ages are particularly proud of having overcome, that even obvious truths remain unspoken for hundreds of years, as if by some agreement, because they look as if they might help those savage beasts, which have been finally slaughtered, come back to life again. Perhaps I am risking something if I allow one such truth to escape me: let others catch it again and give it so much "milk of the devout ways of thinking" to drink, that it lies still and forgotten in its old corner.—People should learn to think differently about cruelty and open their eyes. They should finally learn to get impatient, so that such presumptuous, gross errors no longer brazenly wander around as virtues—like those dealing with tragedy, for example, which have been fattened up by old and new philosophers. Almost everything we call "higher culture" rests on the spiritualization and intensification of cruelty—that's my claim. The "wild beast" hasn't been killed at all: it's alive, it's flourishing. Only it has turned itself

into—a god. What constitutes the painful delight in tragedy is cruelty. What has a pleasing effect in so-called tragic pity, and basically even in everything awe-inspiring right up to the highest and most delicate shudders of metaphysics, gets its sweetness only from the ingredient of cruelty added to the mixture. What the Roman in the arena, the Christian in the raptures of the cross, the Spaniard at the sight of a burning at the stake or a bull fight, the Japanese today who crowds into tragedies, the Parisian suburban worker who feels nostalgic for a bloody revolution, the female fan of Wagner who, with her will unhinged, lets herself “submit to” Tristan and Isolde—what all these people enjoy and try to drink down with mysterious enthusiasm is the spicy liquor of the great Circe, “cruelty.” In saying this, we must of course chase off the foolish psychology of former times, which, so far as cruelty is concerned, knew only how to teach us that it arose at the sight of someone else’s suffering. There is a substantial, over-abundant enjoyment also with one’s own suffering, with making oneself suffer—and wherever people let themselves be convinced about self-denial in a religious sense or about self-mutilation, as with the Phoenicians and ascetics, or in general about depriving themselves of sensual experience and the flesh, about remorse, Puritan pangs of repentance, about a vivisection of the conscience, and about a Pascalian sacrificio dell’intelletto [sacrifice of the intellect], they are secretly seduced and pushed on by cruelty, by that dangerous thrill of cruelty turned against themselves. Finally, people should consider that even the knowledgeable man, when he compels his spirit to acknowledge things against his spirit’s inclinations and often enough also against his heart’s desires—that is, to say No where he’d like to affirm something, to love, to worship—rules as an artist and transformer of cruelty. In fact, every attempt to be profound and thorough is a forceful violation, a willingness to do harm to the basic will of the spirit, which always wants what’s apparent and superficial—in all desire to know there is already a drop of cruelty. 230 Perhaps people don’t readily understand what I’ve said here about a “basic will of the spirit.” So permit me to offer an explanation.—The something which commands, which people call “the spirit,” wishes to be master in and around itself and to feel that it is the master. In its multiplicity it possesses the will to simplicity, a will which ties up, tames, desires to dominate and truly rule. Its needs and capabilities are in this respect the same as those which physiologists indicate belong to everything that lives, grows, and reproduces itself. The power of the spirit to appropriate other things for itself is revealed in its strong inclination to assimilate the new with the old, to simplify what is diverse, to ignore or push away what is totally contradictory, just as it arbitrarily and strongly emphasizes, brings out, and falsifies for its own purposes certain characteristics and lines in what is foreign, in every piece of the “outside world.” Its intention in so doing is the assimilation of new “experiences,” the organization of new things in an old series—and also

for growth, or, to put the matter even more clearly, for the feeling of growth, for the feeling of increased power. An apparently contradictory spiritual drive serves this same will, a suddenly erupting decision in favour of ignorance, an arbitrary shutting out, a slamming of its window, an inner cry of No to this or that thing, a refusal to let something in, a kind of defensive condition against much that can be known, a satisfaction with the darkness, with the sealed-off horizon, an affirmation and endorsement of ignorance: all this is necessary in proportion to the degree of its appropriating power, its “power of digestion,” to speak metaphorically—“the spirit,” in fact, most closely resembles a stomach. With this also belongs the occasional will in the spirit to allow itself to be deceived, perhaps with a high-spirited premonition that something or other is not the case, that we simply allow something or other to be valid, a joy in all uncertainty and ambiguity, an exultant self-indulgence in the capricious narrowness and secrecy of some corner, in what is all too near at hand, in the foreground, in what is magnified or made smaller, in what has been shifted around or made more beautiful, a delight in the arbitrariness of all these expressions of power. Finally with these belongs that not unobjectionable willingness of the spirit to deceive other spirits and to play act in front of them, that constant urge and pressure of a creative, formative, changeable force: here the spirit enjoys its capacity for adopting multiple masks and shiftiness; it also enjoys the feeling of its security in this activity—precisely through its protean art is the spirit, in fact, best defended and hidden!—Working against this will to appearances, to simplification, to masks, to cloaks, in short, to the surface—for every surface is a cloak—is that sublime tendency of the person looking for knowledge who grasps and wants to grasp things thoroughly in their profundity and multiplicity, as a kind of cruelty of the intellectual conscience and taste, which every bold thinker will recognize in himself, provided that he, as is appropriate, has hardened and sharpened his eye for himself long enough and has grown accustomed to strict discipline and to stern language. He’ll say, “There’s something cruel in my spiritual inclination”—let the virtuous and charming try to persuade him that’s not so! In fact, it would sound better if, instead of cruelty, people talked of or whispered about or credited us free, very free spirits as having “excessive honesty”—and perhaps that’s how it will really ring out one day—our posthumous reputation? In the meantime—for there is plenty of time until then—we ourselves may well be the least inclined to dress ourselves up in the finery of these sorts of moralistic word sequins and shawls: our entire work so far spoils for us this very taste and its merry opulence. These are the beautiful, sparkling, jingling, festive words: honesty, love of truth, love of wisdom, sacrifice for knowledge, heroism of the truthful—there is something in them that makes a person’s pride swell up. But we hermits and marmots, we persuaded ourselves long ago, with all the secrecy of a hermit’s conscience, that this worthy verbal pomp also belongs with the old lying finery,

rubbish, and gold dust of unconscious human vanity, and that underneath such flattering colours and repainted surfaces we must once again recognize the terrifying basic text of *homo natura* [natural man]. In fact, to translate men back into nature, to master the many vain and effusive interpretations and connoted meanings which so far have been scribbled and painted over that eternal basic text of *homo natura*, to see to it that in future man stands before man in the same way he, grown hard in the discipline of science, already stands these days before the rest of nature, with the fearless eyes of Oedipus and the blocked ears of Odysseus, deaf to the seductive enticements of the old metaphysical bird-catchers, who for far too long have been piping at him, "You are more! You are higher! You are of a different origin!"—that may be a peculiar and mad task, but it is a task—who wants to deny that? Why did we choose it, this mad task? Or, to put the question differently, "Why knowledge at all?"—Everyone will ask us about that. And we, pressured like this, we, who have already asked ourselves that very question a hundred times, we have found and find no better answer . . .

231 Learning changes us. It achieves what all feeding does which does not merely "preserve,"—as a physiologist knows. But deep in us, really "down there," is naturally something uneducable, a granite of spiritual *fatum* [fate], of predetermined decision and answer to predetermined selected questions. In every cardinal problem a steadfast "That's what I am" speaks out. About men and a women, for example, a thinker cannot learn to think differently; he can only complete his learning—only finally discover how things "stand with him" on this question. Sometimes we find certain solutions to problems which create a strong faith in us in particular. Perhaps from then on we call them our "convictions." Later we see in them mere footsteps to self-knowledge, signposts to the problem which we are—or, better, to the great stupidity which we are, to our spiritual *fatum* [fate], to the uneducable part way "down there." After this rich civility I have just displayed with respect to myself, perhaps there's a better chance that I'll be allowed to speak out a few truths about "woman as such," so long as from now on people realize at the start just how much these are simply my truths. 232 Woman wants to become independent—and for that reason she is beginning to enlighten men about "woman as such"—that is among the most deleterious developments in the general process of making Europe ugly. For what must these crude attempts of female scientific thinking and self-exposure bring to light! Woman has so many reasons for shame; hidden in women is so much pedantry, superficiality, so many characteristics of the school teacher, petty arrogance, petty indulgence, and petty immodesty—just look at the way she interacts with children!—Up to now basically these qualities have best been kept repressed and controlled by fear of man. Woe when the "eternally boring in woman"—she is rich in that!—is first allowed to venture out, when she begins thoroughly and in principle to forget her shrewdness and art, her qualities

of grace, of play, of driving cares away, of mitigating troubles and taking things lightly, as well as her delicate skill with agreeable pleasures! Nowadays we can already hear women's voices which—by holy Aristophanes!—are frightening. They utter threats with medical clarity about what woman wants from man, from start to finish. Is it not in the very worst taste for woman to prepare like this to become scientific? So far, enlightening has fortunately been a man's business, a man's talent—in the process we remained “among ourselves.” In dealing with everything which women write about concerning “woman,” we may finally retain a healthy mistrust whether woman really wants enlightenment about herself—or is capable of wanting it. . . . Unless a woman by doing this is seeking some new finery for herself—so I do think that dressing herself up belongs to the eternally feminine?—well, by doing this she does want to arouse fear of herself:—in that way perhaps she wants to dominate. But she does not want the truth. What does a woman have to do with truth? From the very beginning nothing is stranger, more unfavourable, or more hostile to women than truth—her great art is the lie, her highest concern appearance and beauty. We men should admit it—we honour and love precisely this art and this instinct in woman, we who have a hard time of it and are happy to get our relief by associating with beings under whose hands, looks, and tender foolishness our seriousness, our gravity and profundity, seem almost silly. Finally I put the question: Has a woman ever herself conceded that a woman's head is profound, that a woman's heart is just? And is it not true that, speaking generally, “woman” up to this point has been held in contempt mostly by woman herself—and not at all by us? We men want a woman not to continue compromising herself by enlightenment, just as it was masculine care and consideration for woman that made the church decree *mulier taceat in ecclesia* [let a woman be silent in church]! It was an advantage for woman, when Napoleon let the all-too-eloquent Madame de Staël understand: *mulier taceat in politicis* [let women be silent in politics]!—And I think that a true friend of women is the person who nowadays shouts out to them: *mulier taceat de muliere* [let woman be silent about women]! 233 It reveals a corruption of the instincts—quite apart from revealing bad taste—when a woman makes a direct reference to Madame Roland or Madame de Staël or Mr. George Sand, as if by doing so they had something to prove in favour of the “woman as such.” Among men those names are the three comical woman as such—nothing more!—and the very best unintentional counter-arguments against emancipation and female high handedness.(8) 234 Stupidity in the kitchen, woman as cook, the ghastly absence of intelligent thought in taking care of the nourishment of the family and the master of the house! Woman understands nothing about what food means, and she wants to be the cook! If woman were a thinking creature, then, as cook for thousands of years, she'd surely have found out the most important physiological facts, while at the same time she'd have had to take ownership of

the art of healing! Because of bad female cooks and the complete lack of reason in the kitchen, the development of human beings has been held up for the longest time and suffered the worst damage. Even today things are little better. A speech for fashionable young ladies. 235 There are expressions and successful projections of the spirit; there are aphorisms, a small handful of words, in which an entire culture, an entire society, suddenly crystallizes. Among these belongs that casual remark Madame de Lambert made to her son: “Mon ami, ne vous permettez jamais que de folies, qui vous feront grand plaisir” [My dear, never allow yourself any follies but those which will bring you great pleasure]—which is, by the way, the most motherly and cleverest remark that has ever been directed to a son. 236 What Dante and Goethe believed about women—the former when he sang, “Ella guardava suso, ed io in lei” [She looked upward and I at her] and the latter when he translated this passage as “the Eternally Feminine draws us upward”—I have no doubt that every more aristocratic woman will resist this faith, for that is exactly what she believes about the Eternally Masculine. . . . 237 Seven Short Maxims About Women How the longest boredom flees—when man crawls to us on his knees! Old age, alas, and science, too, give strength to even weak virtue. Dressed in black and speaking never—every woman then looks clever. When things go well, my gratitude goes—to God and the woman who cuts my clothes. When young, a flowery cavern home—when old, a dragon on the roam. A noble name, legs are fine—a man as well—would he were mine! Brief in speech, the sense quite nice—a female ass on treacherous ice! 237a Up to now women have been treated by men like birds which have strayed down to them from some high place or other, like something finer, more sensitive, wilder, stranger, sweeter, and with more soul—but like something which man must lock up so that it does not fly away. 238 To grasp incorrectly the basic problem of “man and woman,” to deny the most profound antagonism here and the necessity for an eternally hostile tension, perhaps in this matter to dream about equal rights, equal education, equal entitlements and duties—that’s a typical sign of a superficial mind. And a thinker who has shown that he’s shallow in this dangerous place—shallow in his instincts!—may in general be considered suspicious or, even worse, betrayed and exposed. Presumably he’ll be too “short” for all the basic questions of life and of life in the future, and he’ll be incapable of any profundity. By contrast, a man who does have profundity in his spirit and in his desires as well, together with that profundity of good will capable of severity and hardness and easily confused with them, can think about woman only in an oriental way: he has to grasp woman as a possession, as a property which he can lock up, as something predetermined for service and reaching her perfection in that service. In this matter he must take a stand on the immense reasoning of Asia, on the instinctual superiority of Asia: just as the Greeks did in earlier times, the best heirs and

students of Asia, who, as is well known, from Homer to the time of Pericles, as they advanced in culture and in the extent of their power, also became step by step stricter with women, in short, more oriental. How necessary, how logical, even how humanly desirable this was: that's something we'd do well to think about for ourselves! 239 In no age has the weak sex been treated with such respect on the part of men as in our time—that's part of the tendency and basic taste of democracy, just like the disrespect for old age. Is it any wonder that this respect immediately leads to abuse? People want more; people learn to make demands. They finally find this toll of respect almost insulting and would prefer a competition for rights, in fact, a completely genuine fight. Briefly put, woman is losing her shame. Let's add to that at once that she is also losing her taste. She is forgetting how to be afraid of man. But the woman who "forgets how to fear" is abandoning her most womanly instincts. The fact that woman dares to come out when that part of men which inspires fear—let's say it more clearly—when the man in men—is no longer wanted and widely cultivated—is reasonable enough, even understandable enough. What's more difficult to grasp is that in this very process—woman degenerates. That's happening today: let's not deceive ourselves about it! Wherever the industrial spirit has triumphed over the military and aristocratic spirit, woman now strives for the economic and legal independence of a clerk: "woman as clerk" stands written on the door of the modern society which is now developing. As she thus empowers herself with new rights and strives to become "master" and writes the "progress" of woman on her flags and banners, it becomes appallingly clear that the opposite is taking place: woman is regressing. Since the French Revolution the influence of woman in Europe has grown smaller in proportion to the increase in her rights and demands, and the "Emancipation of Woman," to the extent that that is desired and demanded by women themselves (and not just by superficial men), has as a result shown itself to be a remarkable symptom of the growing weakening and deadening of the most feminine instincts. There is stupidity in this development, an almost masculine stupidity, about which a well-adjusted woman—who is always an intelligent woman—would have to feel thoroughly ashamed. To lose the instinct for the ground on which one is sure to gain victory, to neglect to practice the art of one's own true weapons, to allow oneself to let go before men, perhaps even "in a book," where previously one used discipline and a refined cunning humility, to work with a virtuous audacity against man's faith in a fundamentally different ideal concealed in woman, some eternally and necessarily feminine, with constant chatter to talk men emphatically out of the idea that woman, like a delicate, strangely wild, and often pleasing domestic animal, must be maintained, cared for, protected, and looked after, the awkward and indignant gathering up of everything slavish and serf-like that has inherently belonged to the position of women in the social order up to this point and that

still does (as if slavery were a counter-argument and not rather a condition of every higher culture, of every enhancement of culture)—what does all this mean, if not a crumbling away of feminine instinct, a loss of femininity? Of course, there are enough idiotic friends of women and corruptors of women among the scholarly asses of the male sex who counsel woman to defeminize herself in this manner and to imitate all the foolish things which make the “man” in Europe and European “manliness” sick—people who want to bring woman down to the level of a “common education,” perhaps even to reading newspapers and discussing politics. Here and there they even want to make women into free spirits and literati: as if a woman without piety were not something totally repulsive or ridiculous to a profound and godless man. Almost everywhere people ruin woman’s nerves with the most sickly and most dangerous of all forms of music (our most recent German music) and make her more hysterical every day and more incapable of her first and last profession, giving birth to strong children. They want to make her in general even more “cultivated” and, as they say, make the “weak sex” strong through culture, as if history did not teach us as emphatically as possible that “cultivating” human beings and making them weak—that is, enfeebling and fracturing the power of the will and making it sick—have always gone hand in hand and that the most powerful and most influential women of the world (in most recent times Napoleon’s mother) can thank the force of their own particular wills—and not their school masters!—for their power and predominance over men. The thing in woman that arouses respect and often enough fear is her nature, which is “more natural” than man’s nature, her genuine predatory and cunning adaptability, her tiger’s claws under the glove, the naïveté of her egotism, her uneducable nature and inner wildness, the incomprehensibility, breadth, and roaming of her desires and virtues. . . . With all this fear, what creates sympathy for this dangerous and beautiful cat “woman” is that she appears to suffer more, to be more vulnerable, more in need of love, and more condemned to suffer disappointment than any other animal. Fear and pity: with these feelings man has stood before woman up to this point, always with one foot already in tragedy, which tears to pieces while it delights. How’s that? And has this now to come to an end? Is the magic spell of woman in the process of being broken? Are women slowly being made boring? O Europe! Europe! We know the horned animal which has always been most attractive to you. Its danger still constantly threatens you! Your old fable could still at some point once again become “history”—once again a monstrous stupidity could gain mastery of you and drag you away! And no god is hiding underneath it, no, only an “idea,” a “modern idea”!(9) NOTES (1) Gustave Flaubert (1820-1880), well known French novelist. [Back to Text] (2) Abbé Ferdinand Galiani (1728-1787), an Italian cleric and philosopher; Madame d’Épinay: Louise d’Épinay (1726-1783), a French writer. [Back to Text] (3) Aristophanes (456-386 BC), a major dramatist

in classical Athens, the foremost writer of Old Comedy. [Back to Text] (4) Charles de Marguetel de Saint-Denis de Saint Evremond (1610-1703), French soldier and writer; Voltaire: pen name of Francois-Marie Arouet (1694-1778), an enormously influential and popular French philosopher and writer. [Back to Text] (5) Chiaja: an urban district in central Naples. [Back to Text] (6) Jeremy Bentham (1748-1832), English utilitarian philosopher and social reformer; Claude Helvétius (1715-1771), French philosopher, condemned by the pope and the government for his godlessness. The mention of a Homeric metaphor may be a reference to the shuffling around of cattle (a description which occurs in the Iliad). The German edition of 1900 contains an additional phrase in the parenthetical remark describing Helvetius: “this sénateur Pococurante, to use Galiani’s expression!” (Sénateur Pococurante, a character in Voltaire’s *Candide*, sets impossibly high standards for everything and thus finds nothing to admire or enjoy). [Back to Text] (7) The French in the last line means: “Without genius and without wit.” [Back to Text] (8) Madame Roland (1754-1793), French historian and writer; George Sand: pen name for Amandine Aurore Dupin (1804-1876), French novelist. [Back to Text] (9) In Greek mythology, the young girl Europa was carried off from Asia Minor across the sea by the god Zeus, who had transformed himself into a beautiful bull. [Back to Text]

==== Part 8: Peoples and Fatherlands

==== Friedrich Nietzsche BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL Translated by Ian Johnston, Vancouver Island University, Nanaimo, British Columbia, Canada Students, teachers, artists, and members of the general public may download and distribute this text without permission and without charge. They may also freely edit the text for their own purposes. All commercial use of this translation, however, is forbidden without the permission of the translator. For comments and questions, please contact Ian Johnston. For a Rich Text Version (Word) of this text, please use the following link: [Beyond Good and Evil \[RTF\]](#) [Table of Contents for Beyond Good and Evil] PART EIGHT PEOPLES AND FATHERLANDS 240 I heard once again for the first time Richard Wagner’s overture to the *Meistersinger*: it is a splendid, overloaded, difficult, and late art, which prides itself on the fact that, in order to understand it, one has to assume that two centuries of music are still vital. It is to the Germans’ credit that such a pride was not misplaced! What juices and forces, what seasons and climates are intermingled here! It impresses us sometimes as old fashioned, sometimes as strange, bitter, and too young; it is as arbitrary as it is conventionally grandiose, if not infrequently mischievous, still more frequently tough and coarse—it has fire and courage and, at the same time, the loose dun-coloured skin of fruits

which become ripe too late. It streams out wide and full, and suddenly a moment of inexplicable hesitation, a gap, as it were, springs up between cause and effect, a pressure that makes us dream, almost a nightmare—but already the old stream of contentment is spreading and widening once more, of manifold contentment, of old and new happiness, which very much includes the happiness of the artist with himself, something he has no desire to conceal, his amazed and happily shared knowledge of the mastery of the means he has used here, new and newly acquired artistic means, so far untried, as he seems to inform us. All in all, no beauty, nothing of the south, nothing of the delicate southern brightness of heaven, nothing of grace, no dance, scarcely any will for logic, indeed a certain awkwardness that is even emphasized, as if the artist wanted to tell us, “That is part of my purpose,” a ponderous drapery, something arbitrarily barbaric and ceremonial, a shimmy of scholarly and venerable precious objects and lace; something German, in the best and worst senses of the word, something manifold, formless, and inexhaustible in the German way, a certain German power and spiritual excess, which has no fear of hiding under the refinements of decay—and which perhaps feels at its best only there, a truly authentic emblem of the German soul, young and obsolete both at the same time, over-rotten and still over-rich for the future. This kind of music expresses best what I think of the Germans: they belong to the day before yesterday and the day after tomorrow—but they still have no today. 241 We “good Europeans,” we too have hours when we allow ourselves a hearty feeling for our fatherland, a tumble and relapse into old loves and narrow places—I have just given a sample of that—hours of national tumults, patriotic apprehensions, and all sorts of other floods of old-fashioned emotion. Slower moving spirits than we are might take a longer period of time to be done with things which with us last and have run their course in a matter of hours—some need half a year, others half a human lifetime, each according to the speed and power with which they digest and “transform their stuff.” In fact, I could think of some dull, hesitant races which, even in our rapidly moving Europe, would require half a century in order to overcome such atavistic attacks of patriotism and attachment to their soil and to return to reason, that is to say, to “good Europeanness [guten Europäerthum]” And while I indulge myself with this possibility, it so happens that I listen in on a conversation between two old “patriots.” They both were obviously hard of hearing and so spoke all the louder. One said, “That man possesses and understands philosophy as much as a peasant or a student in a fraternity. He is still innocent. But what does that matter these days! This is age of the masses, who prostrate themselves before anything built on a massive scale. That’s how it is in politics, as well. If a statesman piles up a new Tower of Babel for them, anything at all that’s immense in power and empire, they call him ‘great.’ What does it matter that in the meantime those of us who are more cautious and reserved still do not give up the

old belief that only a great idea confers greatness on an act or a cause? What if a statesman brought his people into a situation where from that point on they had to practise ‘grand politics,’ something for which they were by nature poorly adapted and prepared, so that it would be necessary for them to sacrifice their old and certain virtues for the sake of a new and doubtful mediocrity—suppose a statesman sentenced his people to a general ‘politicking,’ although up to that point those same people had had better things to do and to think about and in the depth of their souls could not rid themselves of a cautious disgust with the anxiety, emptiness, noise, and devilish squabbling of those peoples who were truly politicking—suppose such a statesman goaded the sleeping passions and desires of his people and turned their earlier shyness and their pleasure in standing to one side into defects, their fondness for foreign things [Ausländerei] and their secret boundlessness into a liability, devalued for them their most heartfelt inclinations, turned their conscience around, made their spirit narrow, and their taste ‘national,’—well, would a statesman who did all those things, someone for whom his people would have to atone through all future time, in the event they had a future, would such a statesman be great?” “Undoubtedly,” the other old patriot answered him vehemently, “otherwise he would have been incapable of doing it! Perhaps it was idiotic to want something like that? But perhaps every great thing was merely idiotic at the beginning!” “That’s an abuse of words!” cried his conversational partner in response, “Strong! Strong! Strong and idiotic! Not great!” The old men had evidently worked themselves up, as they shouted their “truths” into each other’s faces like this. But I, in my happiness and remoteness, thought about how a stronger man will soon become master over the strong, and also how there is a compensation for the spiritual flattening of one people, namely, the deepening of another people.— 242 Now, let’s call what we’re looking for as the distinguishing mark of Europeans “civilization,” or “humanizing,” or “progress”; let’s use a political formula and call it simply, without praise or blame, Europe’s democratic movement: behind all the moral and political foregrounds indicated with such labels, an immense physiological process is completing itself, something whose momentum is constantly growing—the process by which the Europeans are becoming more similar to each other, their growing detachment from the conditions under which arise races linked to a climate and class, their increasing independence from any distinct environment that for centuries wanted to inscribe itself on body and soul with the same demands—hence, the slow emergence of an essentially supra-national and nomadic type of human being, who, physiologically speaking, possesses as his characteristic mark a maximum of the art and power of adaptation. This process of the developing European, which can be held back by great relapses in tempo, but which for that very reason perhaps acquires and augments its vehemence and depth—the

furious storm and stress of “national feeling” still raging today belongs here, along with that anarchism which is just emerging—this process will probably rush ahead to conclusions which its naive proponents and advocates, the apostles of “modern ideas,” are least likely to expect. The same new conditions which will, on average, create a situation in which human beings are homogenous and mediocre—useful, hard-working, practical in many tasks, clever men from an animal herd—are to the highest degree suitable for giving rise to exceptional men with the most dangerous and most attractive qualities. For while that power to adapt, which keeps testing constantly changing conditions and begins a new task with every generation, almost with every decade, by no means makes possible the full power of the type, while the collective impression of such future Europeans probably will be one of many kinds of extremely useful chattering workers with little will power, men who will need a master, someone to give orders, as much as they need their daily bread, and while the democratizing of Europe thus moves towards the creation of a type prepared for slavery in the most subtle sense, the strong man, in single and exceptional cases, will have to turn out stronger and richer than he has perhaps ever been before now—thanks to the absence of prejudice in his education, thanks to the immense multiplicity of practice, art, and mask. What I wanted to say is this: the democratizing of Europe is at the same time an involuntary way of organizing for the breeding of tyrants—understanding that word in every sense, including the most spiritual. 243 I am pleased to hear that our sun is caught up in a rapid movement towards the constellation Hercules, and I hope that men on this earth act like the sun in this respect. And we first, we good Europeans! 244 There was a time when people were accustomed to confer on the Germans, as a mark of distinction, the label “profound.” Now, when the most successful type of the new Germanism craves completely different honours and perhaps finds that everything profound lacks “flair,” it is almost timely and patriotic to doubt whether we were not deceiving ourselves previously with that praise: in short, to wonder whether German profundity is not basically something else, something worse—and something which, thank God, we are about to succeed in removing. So let’s try to learn to think differently about German profundity. For that we don’t have to do anything except a little vivisection on the German soul. More than anything else, the German soul is multifaceted, with various origins, more cobbled together and superimposed than truly constructed. That comes from how it emerged. A German who had the audacity to claim “Alas, two souls dwell within my breast” would be seriously violating the truth, or, putting the matter more correctly, would lag behind the truth by several souls. As a people of the most monstrous mixing and stirring together of races, perhaps even with an excess of the pre-Aryan element, as “a people of the middle” in every sense, the Germans are more incomprehensible, more extensive, more contradictory, more unknown, more

unpredictable, more surprising, and even more terrifying to themselves than other people are—they elude definition and for that reason alone are the despair of the French. It's typical of the Germans that with them the question "What is German?" never dies away. Kotzebue certainly knew his Germans well enough: "We have been acknowledged," they cheered to him—but Sand also thought he knew them. John Paul understood what he was doing when he expressed his anger over Fichte's false but patriotic flatteries and exaggerations—but it is likely that Goethe's thinking about the Germans was different from Jean Paul's, even if he thought he was right in his opinion about Fichte.(1) What did Goethe really think about the Germans?—But he never spoke clearly about many things around him, and all his life he knew how to keep a delicate silence—he probably had good reasons for that. What's certain is that "the Wars of Liberation" did not make him look up in a happier mood, any more than the French Revolution.(2) The event which made him rethink his Faust and, indeed, the entire problem of "man" was the appearance of Napoleon. There are words of Goethe in which, as if from a foreign country, he repudiates with an impatient severity what the Germans reckon as something they can be proud of: he once defined the famous German disposition [Gemüth] as "indulgence towards the weaknesses of strangers and towards one's own." Was he wrong in that? It's characteristic of the Germans that one is rarely completely wrong about them. The German soul has within it lanes and connecting paths; in it there are caves, hiding places, and dungeons. Its lack of order has a great deal of the charm of something full of secrets. The German is well acquainted with the secret routes to chaos. And just as everything loves its own metaphorical likeness, so the German loves clouds and everything unclear, developing, dim, damp, and shrouded: any kind of uncertainty, shapelessness, shifting around, or evolving he senses as something "profound." In himself, the German man does not exist—he is becoming something—he "is developing himself." Hence, "developing" is the essential German discovery and successful stroke in the great realm of philosophical formulas—a governing idea which, along with German beer and German music, is working to Germanize all Europe. Foreigners stand there amazed at and attracted to the riddles which the contradictory nature underlying the German soul presents to them (something Hegel organized into a system and Richard Wagner finally even set to music). "Good natured and malicious"—such a juxtaposition, a contradiction if applied to any other people, unfortunately justifies itself too often in Germany. Just live for a while among the Swabians! The ponderousness of the German scholar, his social tastelessness, gets on alarmingly well with an inner agility in dancing on a tightrope and with a light impudence, faced with which all the gods have by now learned about fear. If people want an *ad oculos* [visual] demonstration "the German soul," let them just look into German taste, into German arts and customs: what a boorish

indifference to “taste”! See how there the noblest and the meanest stand next to each other! How disorderly and rich this entire spiritual household is! The German drags his soul along; he drags along everything he experiences. He digests his events badly—he’s never “finished” with them. German profundity is often only a difficult and hesitant “digestion.” And just as all chronic invalids, all dyspeptics, have an inclination for comfort, so the German loves “openness” and “conventional probity”: how comfortable it is to be open and conventional!—Today that is perhaps the most dangerous and most successful disguise the German knows—this trusting, cooperative, cards-on-the-table nature of German honesty. It is his true Mephistophelean art; with it he can “still go far!” The German lets himself go, as he gazes with true, blue, empty German eyes—and foreigners immediately confuse him with his dressing gown! What I wanted to say is this—let “German profundity” be what it will—when we are entirely among ourselves perhaps we’ll allow ourselves to laugh about it?—we’ll do well to hold its appearance and its good name in honour in future and not to dispose of our old reputation as people of profundity too cheaply for Prussian “dash” and Berlin wit and sand. It’s clever for a people to make itself pass for—and to let others think it—profound, clumsy, good natured, honest, unwise. That could even be—profound! Finally one should be a credit to one’s name—not for nothing are we called the “tiusche” people, the deceiving people . . . 245 The “good old” days are gone. In Mozart they sang themselves out:—how lucky we are that his rococo still speaks to us, that his “good society,” his loving raptures, his childish delight in Chinese effects and curlicues, the civility in his heart, his desire for delicacy, lovers, dancers, those with blissful tears, and his faith in the south can still appeal to some remnant in us! Alas, at some point it will be gone!—But who can doubt that the understanding of and taste for Beethoven will be gone even earlier!—Beethoven was, in fact, only the final chords of a stylistic transition, a break in style, and not, like Mozart, the last notes of a great centuries-long European taste. Beethoven is something that happens between an old worn out soul which is constantly breaking up and a very young soul of the future which is constantly coming on. In his music there lies that half light of eternal loss and of eternally indulgent hoping—that same light in which Europe was bathed when it dreamed with Rousseau, when it danced around the Liberty Tree of revolution and finally almost worshipped before Napoleon. But how quickly now this very feeling fades. Nowadays how difficult it has already become to know this feeling—how foreign to our ears the language of Rousseau, Schiller, Shelley, and Byron sounds, in whom collectively the same European fate found a way in words which it knew how to sing in Beethoven!(3) What has come in German music since then belongs to Romanticism, that is, historically considered, to an even shorter, even more fleeting, even more superficial movement than that great interlude, that transition

in Europe from Rousseau to Napoleon and to the arrival of democracy. There is Weber: but what are Freischütz and Oberon these days for us? Or Marschner's Hans Heiling and Vampyr!(4) Or even Wagner's Tannhauser! That music has faded away, even if it has not yet been forgotten. In addition, all this Romantic music was not sufficiently noble, not sufficiently musical, to justify itself anywhere other than in the theatre and in front of crowds. Right from the start it was second-rate music, of little interest among true musicians. The situation was different with Felix Mendelssohn, that halcyon master, who won rapid admiration for his lighter, purer, and happier soul and then was forgotten just as quickly, as a lovely event in German music.(5) But as for the case of Robert Schumann, who took his work seriously and from the beginning was also taken seriously—he was the last one who founded a school—nowadays don't we count it as good luck, as a relief, and as a liberation that this very Schumann-style Romanticism has been overthrown? Schumann ran off into the "Saxon Switzerland" of his soul, half like Werther, half like Jean-Paul, but certainly nothing like Beethoven, certainly nothing like Byron!—the music of his Manfred is an error in judgment and a misunderstanding to the point of injustice.(6)—Schumann with his taste, which was basically a petty taste (that is, a dangerous tendency, doubly dangerous among the Germans, toward quiet lyricism and a drunken intoxication of feeling), always going off to the side, shyly withdrawing himself and pulling back, a nobly tender soul, who wallowed in nothing but anonymous happiness and sorrow, from the start a sort of young maiden and *noli me tangere* [do not touch me]: this Schumann was already merely a German event in music, no longer something European, as Beethoven was, and, to an even greater extent, Mozart. With him German music was threatened by its greatest danger, the loss of the voice for the soul of Europe and its descent to something dealing merely with the fatherland. 246 What a torture are books written in German for the person who has a third ear! How unwillingly he stands beside the slowly revolving swamp of sounds without melody, of rhythms without dance, what among the Germans is called a "book!" And as for the German who reads books! How lazily, how reluctantly, how badly he reads! How many Germans know and demand from themselves the knowledge that there is art in every good sentence, art which must be correctly grasped if the sentence is to be understood! With a misunderstanding about its tempo, for example, the sentence itself is misunderstood! That one must not be in doubt about the rhythmically decisive syllables, that one must feel the break in the extremely strict symmetry as intentional and charming, that one must lend a refined and patient ear to every staccato and every rubato, that one sorts out the sense in the series of vowels and diphthongs, how softly and richly they can colour and re-colour each other as they follow in their sequence—who among our book-reading Germans has enough goodwill to recognize these sorts of

duties and demands and to listen for so much art and intentionality in the language? In the end we just “don’t have the ear for that.” And thus the most pronounced contrasts in style are not heard and the most refined artistry is wasted, as if on deaf people. These were my thoughts as I observed how crudely and naively people confused two masters of the art of prose with each other—one whose words drip down, hesitant and cold, as if from the roof of a damp cavern—he’s relying on their dull sound and echo—and the other who handles his language like a flexible sword and feels from his arm down to his toes the dangerous joy in the excessively sharp, shimmering blade that wants to bite, hiss, and cut.— 247 Just how little German style concerns itself with sound and with the ear is demonstrated in the fact that even our good musicians write badly. The German does not read aloud, not for the ear, but merely with his eyes. In the process he puts his ears away in a drawer. In antiquity a man read, when he read—and that happened rarely enough—to himself aloud and, in fact, in a loud voice. People were amazed if someone read quietly, and they secretly asked themselves why. With a loud voice—that is to say, with all the swellings, inflections, changes in tone, and shifts in tempo which the ancient public world enjoyed. At that time the principles of writing style were the same as those for the speaking style, and these principles depended in part on the astonishing development and the sophisticated needs of the ear and larynx and in part on the strength, endurance, and power of the ancient lungs. A syntactic period is, as the ancients understood it, above all a physiological totality, insofar as it is held together by a single breath. Such periods, as they manifest themselves in Demosthenes and Cicero, swelling up twice and sinking down twice, all within the single breath—that’s what ancient men enjoyed.(7) From their own schooling they knew how to value the virtue in such periods—how rare and difficult it was to deliver them. We really have no right to the great syntactical period, we moderns, we short-winded people in every sense! These ancient people were, in fact, themselves collectively dilettantes in public speaking—and as a result connoisseurs and thus critics. Hence, they drove their speakers to the utmost limits. In a similar way in the last century, once all Italian men and women understood how to sing, among them virtuoso singing (and with that the art of melody as well) reached its high point. But in Germany (right up until very recent times, when a sort of platform eloquence started flapping its young wings timidly and crudely enough) there was really only one form of public speaking which came close to being artistic: what came from the pulpit. In Germany only the preacher understood what a syllable or what a word weighs, how a sentence strikes, leaps, falls, runs, and comes to an end; only he had a conscience in his ears, often enough a bad conscience. For there is no shortage of reasons why it’s precisely the German who rarely, and almost always too late, achieves a proficiency in speaking. It is appropriate therefore that the masterwork of

German prose is the masterwork of its greatest preacher: up to this point, the Bible has been the best German book. In comparison with Luther's Bible, almost everything else is mere "literature"—something that did not grow in Germany and hence also did not grow and does not grow in German hearts, as the Bible has. 248 There are two kinds of genius: one which above all breeds and desires to breed, and another which is happy to let itself be fertilized and give birth. In just the same way, there are among peoples of genius those to whom the female problem of pregnancy and the secret task of shaping, maturing, and perfecting have been assigned—the Greeks, for example, were a people of this kind, like the French—and there are others who have to fertilize and become the origin of new orders of life—like the Jews, the Romans, and, one could ask in all modesty, the Germans?—People tormented and enchanted by unknown fevers and irresistibly driven outside themselves, in love with and lusting after foreign races (after those who "let themselves be fertilized"—) and thus obsessed with mastery, like everything which has a knowledge of itself as full of procreative power and thus "by the grace of God." These two types of genius seek each other out, like man and woman, but they also misunderstand each other—like man and woman. 249 Every people has its characteristic *Tartufferie* [hypocrisy] and calls it its virtues.—The best that man is he does not know—he cannot know. 250 What does Europe owe the Jews?—All sorts of things, good and bad, and above all one that is at the same time among the best and the worst: the grand style in morality, the terror and majesty of infinite demands, infinite meanings, the whole romanticism and grandeur of morally questionable things [*moralischen Fragwürdigkeiten*]*—and as a result precisely the most attractive, most insidious, and most exquisite parts of those plays of colours and enticements to life, whose afterglow these days makes the sky of our European culture glow in its evening light—perhaps as it burns itself out. Among the spectators and philosophers, we artists are grateful to the Jews for that. 251 When a people is suffering from nationalistic nervous fever and political ambition and wants to suffer, we have to accept the fact that various kinds of clouds and disturbances—in short, small attacks of stupidity—will pass over its spirit: for example, among contemporary Germans sometimes the anti-French stupidity, sometimes the anti-Jewish, sometimes the anti-Polish, sometimes the Christian-Romantic, sometimes the Wagnerian, sometimes the Teutonic, sometimes the Prussian (take a look at these poor historians Sybel and Treitzschke and their thickly bandaged heads—), and whatever else all these small obfuscations of the German spirit and conscience may call themselves.*(8) May I be forgiven for the fact that I, too, during a short and risky stay in a very infected region did not remain entirely free of this illness and, like all the world, began to have ideas about things which were no concern of mine, the first sign of the political infection. For example, about the Jews. Hear me out.—I have not yet met a single German who was well disposed

towards the Jews. And no matter how absolute the rejection of real anti-Semitism on the part of all cautious and political types may be, nonetheless this caution and politics directs itself not against this type of feeling itself, but only against its dangerous excess, in particular against the tasteless and disgraceful expression of this excessive feeling—on that point people should not deceive themselves. That Germany has a richly sufficient number of Jews, that the German stomach and German blood have difficulty (and will still have difficulty for a long time to come) absorbing even this quantum of “Jew”—in the way the Italians, the French, and the English have absorbed them, as a result of a stronger digestive system—that is the clear message and language of a general instinct which we must listen to and according to which we must act. “Let no more Jews in! And especially bar the doors to the east (also to Austria)!” So orders the instinct of a people whose type is still weak and uncertain, so that it could be easily erased, easily dissolved away by a stronger race. But the Jews are without any doubt the strongest, most tenacious, and purest race now living in Europe. They understand how to prevail even under the worst conditions (better even than under favourable conditions), as a result of certain virtues which today people might like to stamp as vices—thanks, above all, to a resolute faith which has no need to feel shame when confronted by “modern ideas.” They always change, if they change, only in the way the Russian empire carries out its conquests—as an empire that has time and was not born yesterday—that is, according to the basic principle “as slowly as possible!” A thinker who has the future of Europe on his conscience will, in all the designs he draws up for himself of this future, take the Jews as well as the Russians into account as, for the time being, the surest and most probable factors in the great interplay and struggle of forces. What we nowadays call a “nation” in Europe is essentially more a *res facta* [something made] than a *res nata* [something born] (indeed sometimes it looks confusingly like a *res ficta et picta* [something made up and unreal]—), in any case something developing, young, easily displaced, not yet a race, to say nothing of *aere perennius* [more enduring than bronze], as is the Jewish type. But these “nations” should be very wary of every hot-headed competition and enmity! That the Jews, if they wanted to—or if people were to force them, as the anti-Semites seem to want to do—could even now become predominant, in fact, quite literally gain mastery over Europe, is certain; that they are not working and planning for that is equally certain. Meanwhile, by contrast, they desire and wish—even with a certain insistence—to be absorbed into and assimilated by Europe. They thirst to be finally established somewhere or other, to be accepted and respected, and to bring to an end their nomadic life, to the “Wandering Jew.” And people should pay full attention to this tendency and impulse (which in itself perhaps even expresses a moderating of Jewish instincts) and accommodate it. And for this, it might perhaps be useful and reasonable to expel the noisy anti-Semitic

troublemakers from the country. We should welcome them with all caution, and selectively, more or less the way the English aristocracy does. It's clear that the stronger and already more firmly established type of the new Germanism could involve itself with them with the least objection, for example, the aristocratic officers from the Mark Brandenburg.(9) It would be interesting in all sorts of ways to see whether the genius for money and patience (and above all for some spirit and spirituality, which are seriously deficient in the people just referred to) could be added to and bred into the inherited art of commanding and obeying—in both of which the land mentioned above is nowadays a classic example. But at this point it's fitting that I break off my cheerful Germanomania [Deutschthümelei] and speech of celebration. For I'm already touching on something serious to me, on the "European problem," as I understand it, on the breeding of a new ruling caste for Europe.— 252 These Englishmen are no race of philosophers. Bacon signifies an attack on the spirit of philosophy generally; Hobbes, Hume, and Locke have been a debasement and a devaluing of the idea of a "philosopher" for more than a century. Kant raised himself and rose up in reaction against Hume. It was Locke of whom Schelling was entitled to say, "Je méprise Locke" [I despise Locke].(10) In the struggle with the English mechanistic dumbing down of the world, Hegel and Schopenhauer (along with Goethe) were unanimous—both of these hostile fraternal geniuses in philosophy, who moved away from each other towards opposite poles of the German spirit and, in the process, wronged each other, as only brothers do. What's lacking in England, and what has always been missing, that's something the semi-actor and rhetorician Carlyle understood well enough, that tasteless muddle-headed Carlyle, who tried to conceal under his passionate grimaces what he understood about himself, that is, what was lacking in Carlyle—a real power of spirituality, a real profundity of spiritual insight, in short, philosophy.(11) It is characteristic of such an unphilosophical race that it clings strongly to Christianity. They need its discipline to develop their "moralizing" and humanizing. The Englishman is more gloomy, more sensual, stronger willed, and more brutal than the German—he is also for that very reason, as the more vulgar of the two, also more pious than the German. He is even more in need of Christianity. For more refined nostrils even this English Christianity has still a lingering and truly English smell of spleen and alcoholic dissipation, against which it is used with good reason as a medicinal remedy—that is, the more delicate poison against the coarser one. Among crude people, a subtler poisoning is, in fact, already progress, a step towards spiritualization. The crudity and peasant seriousness of the English are still most tolerably disguised or, stated more precisely, interpreted and given new meaning, by the language of Christian gestures and by prayers and singing psalms. And for those drunken and dissolute cattle who in earlier times learned to make moral grunts under the influence of Methodism and, more recently, once

again as the “Salvation Army,” a twitch of repentance may really be, relatively speaking, the highest achievement of “humanity” to which they can be raised: that much we can, in all fairness, concede. But what is still offensive even in the most humane Englishman is his lack of music, speaking metaphorically (and not metaphorically—). He has in the movements of his soul and his body no rhythm and dance—in fact, not even the desire for rhythm and dance, for “music.” Listen to him speak, or watch the most beautiful English woman walk—in no country of the earth are there lovelier doves and swans—and finally, listen to them sing! But I’m demanding too much . . . 253 There are truths which are best recognized by mediocre heads, because they are most appropriate for them; there are truths which have charm and seductive power only for mediocre minds:—at this very point we are pushed back onto this perhaps unpleasant proposition, since the time the spirit of respectable but mediocre Englishmen—I cite Darwin, John Stuart Mill, and Herbert Spencer—is successfully gaining pre-eminence in the middle regions of European taste.(12) In fact, who could doubt how useful it is that such spirits rule from time to time? It would be a mistake to think that highly cultivated spirits who fly off to great distances would be particularly skilful at establishing many small, common facts, collecting them, and pushing to a conclusion:—they are, by contrast, as exceptional men, from the very start in no advantageous position vis-à-vis the “rules.” In the final analysis, they have more to do than merely have knowledge—for they have to be something new, to mean something new, to present new values! The gap between knowing something and being able to do something is perhaps greater as well as more mysterious than people think. It’s possible that the man who can act in the grand style, the creating man, will have to be a person who does not know; whereas, on the other hand, for scientific discoveries of the sort Darwin made a certain narrowness, aridity, and conscientious diligence, in short, something English, may not be an unsuitable arrangement. Finally we should not forget that the English with their profoundly average quality have already once brought about a collective depression of the European spirit. What people call “modern ideas” or “the ideas of the eighteenth century” or even “French ideas”—in other words, what the German spirit has risen against with a deep disgust—were English in origin. There’s no doubt of that. The French have been only apes and actors of these ideas, their best soldiers, as well, and at the same time unfortunately their first and most complete victims. For with the damnable Anglomania of “modern ideas” the *âme française* [French soul] has finally become so thin and emaciated that nowadays we remember almost with disbelief its sixteenth and seventeenth centuries, its profoundly passionate power, its resourceful nobility. But with our teeth we must hang on to the following principle of historical fairness and defend it against the appearance of the moment: European noblesse [nobility]—in feeling, in taste, in customs, in short, the word taken in every higher sense—is

the work and invention of France; European nastiness, the plebeian quality of modern ideas, the work of England. 254 Even now France is still the place with the most spiritual and most refined European culture and the leading school of taste. But we have to know how to find this “France of taste.” Whoever belongs to it keeps himself well concealed—the number of those in whom it is embodied and lives may be small, and in addition they may perhaps be people who are not standing on the strongest legs, partly fatalistic, dark, sick, and partly mollycoddled and artificial, such people as have the ambition to conceal themselves. All of them have something in common: confronted with the raging stupidity and the noisy chattering of the democratic bourgeois, they keep their ears plugged. In fact, rolling around these days in the foreground is a stupid and coarsened France—recently, at the funeral of Victor Hugo, it celebrated a true orgy of tastelessness and at the same time of self-admiration.(13) Something else is also common to them: a great will to stand against spiritual Germanization—and an even greater inability to do so! Perhaps these days Schopenhauer is already more at home and has become more indigenous in this France of the spirit, which is also a France of pessimism, than he ever was in Germany, not to mention Heinrich Heine, who has long since been transformed into the flesh and blood of the more sophisticated and discriminating Parisian lyric poets, or Hegel, who today exercises an almost tyrannical influence in the form of Taine, the pre-eminent living historian.(14) And so far as Richard Wagner is concerned—the more French music learns to shape itself according to the real needs of the *âme moderne* [modern soul], the more it will become “Wagnerian.” That’s something we can predict—it’s already doing enough of that now. Nonetheless, in spite of all the voluntary or involuntary Germanizing and vulgarizing of taste, there are three things which nowadays the French can still point to with pride as their inheritance and property and as the indelible mark of an old cultural superiority over Europe. The first is the capacity for artistic passions, for devotion to “form,” for which the expression *l’art pour l’art* [art for art’s sake] has been invented, along with a thousand others—something like that has been present in France for three centuries and, thanks to the reverence for the “small number,” has made possible again and again a kind of chamber music in literature, which is not to be found in the rest of Europe.—The second thing on which the French can base a superiority over Europe is their ancient, multifaceted, moralistic culture, because of which we find, on average, even in the small romanciers [novelists] of the newspapers and random boulevardiers de Paris [Parisian men about town], a psychological sensitivity and curiosity of which people in Germany, for example, have no idea (to say nothing of the thing itself!). For that the Germans are lacking a couple of centuries of moralistic behaviour which, as mentioned, France did not spare itself. Anyone who calls the Germans “naive” because of this is praising them for a defect. (In contrast to the

German inexperience and innocence in voluptate psychologica [in psychological delight], which is not too distantly related to the boredom of associating with Germans—and as the most successful expression of a genuine French curiosity and talent for invention in this empire of tender thrills, Henry Beyle [Stendhal] may well qualify, that remarkably prescient and pioneering man, who ran at a Napoleonic tempo through his Europe, through several centuries of the European soul, as a tracker and discoverer of this soul. It took two generations to catch up with him somehow, to grasp some of the riddles which tormented and delighted him, this strange Epicurean and question mark of a man, who was France's last great psychologist). There is still a third claim to superiority: in the nature of the French there is a semi-successful synthesis of north and south, which enables them to understand many things and tells them to do other things which an Englishman will never understand. In the French, the temperament which periodically turns towards and away from the south and in which, from time to time, the Provencal and Ligurian blood bubbles over, protects them from the dreadful northern gray on gray and the sunless conceptual ghostliness and anaemia—our German sickness of taste, against the excesses of which at the moment we have prescribed for ourselves, with great decisiveness, blood and iron—or I should say “grand politics” (in accordance with a dangerous art of healing which teaches me to wait and wait, but up to this point has not taught me to hope).(15) Even today there is still in France an advance understanding of and an accommodation with those rarer and rarely satisfied people who are too all-embracing to find their contentment in some patriotism or other and know how to love the south in the north and the north in the south—the born mid-landers, the “good Europeans.”—For them Bizet created his music, this last genius who saw a new beauty and enticement and—who discovered a piece of the south in music. (16) 255 I think all sorts of precautions are necessary against German music. Suppose that someone loves the south the way I love it, as a great school for convalescing in the most spiritual and sensual sense, as an unrestrained abundance of sun and transfiguration by the sun, which spreads itself over an existence which rules itself and believes in itself. Now, such a man will learn to be quite careful as far as German music is concerned, because in ruining his taste again it ruins his health again as well. Such a man of the south, not by descent but by faith, must, if he dreams of the future of music, also dream of a redemption of music from the north and have in his ears the prelude to a more profound, more powerful, perhaps more evil and more mysterious music, a supra-German music which does not fade away, turn yellow, and grow pale at the sight of the blue voluptuous sea and the brightness of the Mediterranean sky, the way all German music does, a supra-European music which justifies itself even when confronted with the brown desert sunsets, whose soul is related to the palm trees and knows how to be at home and to wander among huge, beautiful,

solitary, predatory beasts. . . . I could imagine to myself a music whose rarest magic consisted in the fact that it no longer knew anything about good and evil, only that perhaps here and there some mariner's nostalgia or other, some golden shadow and tender weaknesses would race across it, an art which from a great distance could see speeding towards it the colours of a sinking moral world—one which has become almost unintelligible—and which would be sufficiently hospitable and deep to take in such late fugitives.— 256 Thanks to the pathological alienation which the nationalist idiocy has established and still establishes among European peoples, thanks as well to the short-sighted politicians with hasty hands, who with the help of this idiocy are on top nowadays and have no sense of how much the politics of disintegration which they carry on can necessarily be only politics for an intermission—thanks to all this and to many things today which are quite impossible to utter, now the most unambiguous signs indicating that Europe wants to become a unity are being overlooked or willfully and mendaciously reinterpreted. With all the more profound and more comprehensive men of this century the real overall direction in the mysterious work of their souls has been to prepare the way to this new synthesis and to anticipate, as an experiment, the European of the future. Only in their foregrounds or in their weaker hours, as in old age, for example, did they belong to their “fatherlands”—they were only taking a rest from themselves when they became “patriots.” I’m thinking of men like Napoleon, Goethe, Beethoven, Stendhal, Heinrich Heine, and Schopenhauer. Don’t get upset with me if I also count Richard Wagner among them. About him people should not let themselves be seduced by his own misunderstandings—geniuses of his kind rarely have the right to understand themselves. Even less, of course, by the uncivilized noise with which people in France these days close themselves off from and resist Richard Wagner. Nonetheless, the fact remains that the late French Romanticism of the forties and Richard Wagner belong together in the closest and most inner relation. In all the heights and depths of their needs they are related to each other, fundamentally related. It is Europe, the one Europe, whose soul pushes out and upward through their manifold and impetuous art, and it longs to go—where? Into a new light? Towards a new sun? But who could express exactly what all these masters of new ways of speaking did not know how to express clearly? What is certain is that the same storm and stress tormented them, that they sought in the same way, these last great seekers! All of them were dominated by literature up to their eyes and ears—the first artists educated in world literature—most of them were even themselves writers, poets, conveyers of and mixers in the arts and senses (Wagner belongs as a musician with the painters, as a poet with the musicians, as an artist generally with the actors); they were all fanatics of expression “at any price”—I’ll cite Delacroix, the one most closely related to Wagner—they were all great discoverers in the

realm of the sublime, as well as of the ugly and the horrific, even greater discoverers in effects, in display, in the art of the store window—all talents far beyond their genius, virtuosos through and through, with mysterious access to everything that seduces, entices, compels, knocks over, born enemies of logic and the straight line, greedy for the strange, the exotic, the monstrous, the crooked, the self-contradictory; as men they were Tantaluses of the will, up-and-coming plebeians, who knew that they were incapable of a noble tempo, a *lento* [slow movement], in their lives and works—think, for example, of Balzac—unrestrained workers, almost killing themselves with work, antinomians and rebels against morals, ambitious and insatiable without equilibrium and enjoyment; all of them finally collapsing and sinking down before the Christian cross (and they were right and justified in that, for who among them would have been sufficiently profound and original for a philosophy of the Antichrist?—), on the whole, a boldly daring, marvellously violent, high-flying kind of higher men, who pulled others up into the heights, men who first taught the idea of “higher man” to their century—and it’s the century of the masses!(17) The German friends of Richard Wagner should think about whether there is anything essentially German in Wagnerian art or whether it is not precisely its distinction that it comes from supra-German sources and urges. In doing that, one should not underestimate just how indispensable Paris was for the development of a type like him, how at the most decisive period the depth of his instincts called him there, and how his whole way of appearing and his self-apostleship could perfect itself only at the sight of the model of French socialists. Perhaps with a more sophisticated comparison people will discover, to the honour of Richard Wagner’s German nature, that he carried everything out more strongly, more daringly, harder, and higher than a Frenchman of the nineteenth century could have done—thanks to the fact that we Germans are still closer to barbarism than the French are. Perhaps the most peculiar thing that Richard Wagner created is even inaccessible and unsympathetic to and beyond the emulation of the entire Latin race, which is so mature, for all time and not merely for today: the character of Siegfried, that very free man, who, in fact, may be far too free, too hard, too cheerful, too healthy, too anti-Catholic for the taste of an old and worn cultured people. He may even have been a sin against Romanticism, this anti-Roman [antiromanische] Siegfried. Well, Wagner more than made up for this sin in his old and gloomy days when—in anticipation of a taste which in the meantime has become political—he began, with his characteristic religious vehemence, if not to go to Rome, at least to preach the way there. So that you do not misunderstand these last words of mine, I’ll summon a few powerful rhymes to my assistance, which will reveal what I mean to less refined ears as well—what I have against the “late Wagner” and his Parsifal music: Is that still German? Did this oppressive screech come from a German heart? Is this self-

mutilation of the flesh a German part? And is this German, such priestly affectation, this incense-smelling, sensual stimulation? And German this faltering, plunging, staggering, this uncertain bim-bam dangling? This nun-like ogling and ringing Ave bells, this whole false heavenly super-heaven of spells? Is that still German? Think! You're still standing by the entrance way. You're hearing Rome, Rome's faith without the words they say. NOTES (1) August Kotzebue (1761-1819), a well-known German writer assassinated by Karl Sand (1795-1820); John Paul (1763-1825), pen name of Johann Richter, an influential German writer in the Romantic era; Johann Gottlieb Fichte (1797-1879), an influential German philosopher. [Back to Text] (2) Wars of Liberation: the wars against Napoleon which followed the French Revolution. [Back to Text] (3) Napoleon Bonaparte (1769-1821) French general, ruler of France, and conqueror of much of Europe; Rousseau: Jean-Jacques Rousseau (1712-1778), critic, philosopher and writer whose work influenced the French Revolution; Schiller: Johann Christoph Friedrich von Schiller (1759-1805), German poet, playwright, and philosopher; Shelley: Percy Bysshe Shelley (1792-1822), a major English poet in the Romantic era; Byron: George Gordon Byron (Lord Byron) (1788-1824), English poet in the Romantic era, a leading international presence in European Romanticism. [Back to Text] (4) Carl Maria Friedrich Ernst von Weber (1786-1826), German musician during the Romantic period; Heinrich Marschner (1795-1861), German composer of operas. [Back to Text] (5) Felix Mendelssohn (1809-1847) German composer in the early Romantic period. [Back to Text] (6) Robert Schumann (1810-1856) German composer and music critic; Werther: hero of a famous Romantic novel by Goethe (he commits suicide). [Back to Text] (7) Cicero (106-43 BC), the greatest of the Roman orators and prose stylists; Demosthenes (384-322 BC), a very famous Greek orator. [Back to Text] (8) Heinrich von Sybel (1817-1895) and Heinrich von Treitschke (1834-1896), important mid-nineteenth century German historians. [Back to Text] (9) Mark Brandenburg: a region near Berlin. [Back to Text] (10) Thomas Hobbes (1588-1679), English philosopher; David Hume (1711-1776), Scottish historian and philosopher; John Locke (1632-1704), English philosopher; Friedrich Wilhelm Joseph Schelling (1775-1854), German philosopher. [Back to Text] (11) Thomas Carlyle (1795-1881), Scottish essayist, historian, and biographer. [Back to Text] (12) Charles Darwin (1809-1882) English scientist, whose *Origin of Species* was published in 1859; John Stuart Mill (1806-1873), English utilitarian philosopher and economist; Herbert Spencer (1820-1903), English philosopher. [Back to Text] (13) Victor Hugo (1802-1885), French poet, playwright, and novelist. [Back to Text] (14) Heinrich Heine (1797-1856), German lyric poet; Hippolyte Adolphe Taine (1828-1893), French critic and historian. [Back to Text] (15) blood and iron: a phrase made famous by Otto Eduard Leopold von Bismarck (1815-1898), First Chancellor of

Germany: “Not by speeches and votes of the majority are the great questions of the time decided . . . but by iron and blood.” [Back to Text] (16) Georges Bizet (1838-1875), French composer and pianist. [Back to Text] (17) Ferdinand Victor Eugene Delacroix (1798-1863), important French Romantic painter; Honore de Balzac (1799-1850), prolific French novelist. [Back to Text]

==== Part 9: What is Noble?

==== Friedrich Nietzsche BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL Translated by Ian Johnston, Vancouver Island University, Nanaimo, British Columbia, Canada
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Every enhancement in the type “man” up to this point has been the work of an aristocratic society—and that’s how it will always be, over and over again: a society that believes in a long scale of rank ordering and differences in worth between one person and another and that, in some sense or other, requires slavery. Without the pathos of distance, the sort which grows out of the deeply rooted difference between the social classes, out of the constant gazing outward and downward of the ruling caste on the subjects and work implements, and out of their equally sustained practice of obedience and command, holding down and holding at a distance, that other more mysterious pathos would have no chance of growing at all, that longing for an ever new widening of distances inside the soul itself, the development of ever higher, rarer, more distant, more expansive, more comprehensive states, in short, simply the enhancement in the type “man,” the constant “self-surmounting of man,” to cite a moral formula in a supra-moral sense. Of course, where the history of the origins of aristocratic society is concerned (and thus the precondition for that raising of the type “man”—), we should not surrender to humanitarian illusions: truth is hard. So without further consideration, let’s admit to ourselves how up to this point every higher culture on earth has started! People with a still natural nature, barbarians in every dreadful sense of the word, predatory men still in possession of an unbroken power of the will and a desire for power, threw themselves on weaker, more civilized, more peaceful, perhaps trading or cattle-raising races, or on old, worn cultures, in which at that very moment the final forces of life were flickering out in a dazzling fireworks display of spirit and corruption. At the start the noble caste has always been the barbarian caste: its superiority has lain not primarily in

physical might but in spiritual power—it has been a matter of more complete human beings (which at every level also means “more complete beasts”). 258 Corruption as the expression of the fact that within the instincts anarchy is threatening and that the foundation of the affects, what we call “life,” has been shaken: according to the living structure in which it appears, corruption is something fundamentally different. When, for example, an aristocracy, like that in France at the start of the Revolution, throws away its privileges with a sublime disgust and sacrifices itself to a dissipation of its moral feelings, this is corruption:—essentially it was only the final act in that centuries-long corruption, thanks to which the aristocracy step-by-step gave up its ruling authority and reduced itself to a function of the monarchy (finally even to the monarch’s finery and display pieces). The essential thing in a good and healthy aristocracy, however, is that it feels itself not as a function (whether of a monarchy or of a community) but as its significance and highest justification—that it therefore with good conscience accepts the sacrifice of an enormous number of people, who for its sake must be oppressed and reduced to incomplete men, to slaves and instruments of work. Its fundamental belief must, in fact, be that the society should exist, not for the sake of the society, but only as a base and framework on which an exceptional kind of nature can raise itself to its higher function and, in general, to a higher form of being, comparable to those heliotropic climbing plants on Java—people call them *sipo matador*—whose tendrils clutch an oak tree so much and for so long until finally, high over the tree but supported by it, they can unfold their crowns in the open light and make a display of their happiness.— 259 Mutually refraining from wounding each other, from violence, and from exploitation, and setting one’s will on the same level as others—these can in a certain crude sense become good habits among individuals, if conditions exist for that (namely, a real similarity in the quality of their power and their estimates of value, as well as their belonging together within a single body). However, as soon as people wanted to take this principle further and, where possible, establish it as the basic principle of society, it would immediately show itself for what it is, as the willed denial of life, as the principle of disintegration and decay. Here we must think through to the fundamentals and push away all sentimental weakness: living itself is essentially appropriation from and wounding and overpowering strangers and weaker people, oppression, hardness, imposing one’s own forms, annexing, and at the very least, in its mildest actions, exploitation—but why should we always use these precise words, which have from ancient times carried the stamp of a slanderous purpose? Even that body in which, as previously mentioned, individuals deal with each other as equals—and that happens in every healthy aristocracy—must itself, if it is a living body and not dying out, do to other bodies all those things which the individuals in it refrain from doing to each

other: it will have to be the living will to power, it will seek to grow, grab things around it, pull to itself, and acquire predominance—not because of some morality or immorality, but because it is alive and because living is simply the will to power. But in no point is the common consciousness of the European more reluctant to be instructed than here. Nowadays people everywhere, even those in scientific disguises, are raving about the coming conditions of society from which “the exploitative character” is to have disappeared:—to my ears that sounds as if people had promised to invent a life which abstained from all organic functions. The “exploitation” is not part of a depraved or incomplete and primitive society: it belongs to the essential nature of what is living, as a basic organic function; it is a consequence of the real will to power, which is simply the will to life.—Assuming that this is something new as a theory—it is, nonetheless, in reality the fundamental fact of all history: we should at least be honest with ourselves to this extent! 260 As the result of a stroll through the many more sophisticated and cruder moral systems which up to this point have ruled or still rule on earth, I found certain characteristics routinely return with each other, bound up together, until finally two basic types revealed themselves to me and a fundamental difference sprang up. There is master morality, and there is slave morality—to this I immediately add that in all higher and more mixed cultures attempts at a mediation between both moralities make an appearance as well, even more often, a confusion and mutual misunderstanding between the two, in fact, sometimes their close juxtaposition—even in the same person, within a single soul. Distinctions in moral value have arisen either among a ruling group which was happily conscious of its difference with respect to the ruled—or among the ruled, the slaves and dependent people of every degree. In the first case, when it’s the masters who establish the idea of the “good,” the elevated and proud conditions of the soul emotionally register as the distinguishing and defining order of rank. The noble man separates his own nature from that of people in whom the opposite of such exalted and proud states expresses itself. He despises them. We should notice at once that in this first kind of morality the opposites “good” and “bad” mean no more than “noble” and “despicable”—the opposition between “good” and “evil” has another origin. The despised one is the coward, the anxious, the small, the man who thinks about narrow utility, also the suspicious man with his inhibited look, the self-abasing man, the species of human dogs who allow themselves to be mistreated, the begging flatterer, and, above all, the liar:—it is a basic belief of all aristocrats that the common folk are liars. “We tellers of the truth”—that’s what the nobility called itself in ancient Greece. It’s evident that distinctions of moral worth everywhere were first applied to men and then later, by extension, were established for actions; hence, it is a serious mistake when historians of morality take as a starting point questions like “Why was the compassionate action praised?” The noble kind of

man experiences himself as a person who determines value and who does not need other people's approval. He makes the judgment "What is harmful to me is harmful in itself." He understands himself as something which in general first confers honour on things, as something which creates values. Whatever he recognizes in himself he honours. Such a morality is self-glorification. In the foreground stands the feeling of fullness, the power which wants to overflow, the happiness of high tension, the consciousness of riches which wants to give presents and provide:—the noble man also helps the unfortunate, however not, or hardly ever, from pity, but more in response to an impulse which the excess of power produces. The noble person honours the powerful man in himself and also the man who has power over himself, who understands how to speak and how to keep silent, who takes delight in dealing with himself severely and toughly, and who respects, above all, severity and toughness. "Wotan set a hard heart in my breast," it says in an old Scandinavian saga: that's poetry emerging from the soul of a proud Viking—and justifiably so. A man of this sort is simply proud of the fact that he has not been made for pity. That's why the hero of the saga adds a warning, "In a man whose heart is not hard when he is still young it will never become hard." Noble and brave men who think this way are furthest removed from that morality which sees the badge of morality specifically in pity or in actions for others or in *désintéressement* [disinterestedness]. The belief in oneself, pride in oneself, a fundamental hostility and irony against "selflessness" belong to noble morality, just as much as an easy contempt and caution before feelings of pity and the "warm heart." Powerful men are the ones who understand how to honour; that is their art, their realm of invention. The profound reverence for age and for ancestral tradition—all justice stands on this double reverence—the belief and the prejudice favouring forefathers and working against newcomers are typical in the morality of the powerful, and when, by contrast, the men of "modern ideas" believe almost instinctively in "progress" and the "future" and increasingly lack any respect for age, then in that attitude the ignoble origin of these "ideas" already reveals itself well enough. However, a morality of the rulers is most alien and embarrassing to present taste because of the severity of its basic principle that man has duties only with respect to those like him, that man should act towards those beings of lower rank, towards everything foreign, at his own discretion, or "as his heart dictates," and, in any case, "beyond good and evil." Here pity and things like that may belong. The capacity for and obligation to a long gratitude and a long revenge—both only within the circle of one's peers—the sophistication in paying back again, the refined idea in friendship, a certain necessity to have enemies (as, so to speak, drainage ditches for the feelings of envy, quarrelsomeness, and high spirits—basically in order to be capable of being a good friend): all those are typical characteristics of a noble morality, which, as indicated, is not the morality of

“modern ideas” and which is thus nowadays difficult to sympathize with, as well as difficult to dig up and expose. Things are different with the second type of moral system, slave morality. Suppose the oppressed, depressed, suffering and unfree people, those ignorant of themselves and tired out, suppose they moralize: what will be the common feature of their moral estimates of value? Probably a pessimistic suspicion directed at the entire human situation will express itself, perhaps a condemnation of man, along with his situation. The gaze of a slave is not well disposed towards the virtues of the powerful; he possesses scepticism and mistrust; he has a subtlety of mistrust of everything “good” that is honoured in those virtues—he would like to persuade himself that even happiness is not genuine there. By contrast, those characteristics will be pulled forward and flooded with light which serve to mitigate existence for those who suffer: here respect is given to pity, to the obliging hand ready to help, to the warm heart, to patience, diligence, humility, and friendliness—for these are here the most useful characteristics and almost the only means to endure the pressure of existence. Slave morality is essentially a morality of utility. Here is the focus for the origin of that famous opposition of “good” and “evil”:—people sense power and danger within evil, a certain terror, subtlety, and strength that does not permit contempt to spring up. According to slave morality, the “evil” man thus inspires fear; according to master morality, it is precisely the “good” man who inspires and desires to inspire fear, while the “bad” man is felt as despicable. This opposition reaches its peak when, in accordance with the consequences of slave morality, finally a trace of disregard is also attached to the “good” of this morality—it may be light and benevolent—because within the way of thinking of the slave the good person must definitely be the harmless person: he is good natured, easy to deceive, perhaps a bit stupid, un bonhomme [a good fellow]. Wherever slave morality gains predominance the language reveals a tendency to bring the words “good” and “stupid” into closer proximity. A final basic difference: the longing for freedom, the instinct for happiness, and the refinements of the feeling for freedom belong just as necessarily to slave morality and morals as art and enthusiasm in reverence and in devotion are the regular symptoms of an aristocratic way of thinking and valuing. From this we can without further ado understand why love as passion—which is our European specialty—must clearly have a noble origin: as is well known, its invention belongs to the Provencal knightly poets, those splendidly inventive men of the “gay saber” [gay science] to whom Europe owes so much—almost its very self. 261 Vanity is among the things that are perhaps hardest for a noble man to understand: he will be tempted even to deny its existence where another kind of man thinks he has grasped it with both hands. For him the problem is imagining to himself beings who seek to elicit a good opinion of themselves which they themselves do not possess—and which, as a result, they also have not “earned”—people who,

nonetheless, themselves later believe in this good opinion. Half of this seems to the noble man so tasteless and disrespectful of oneself and the other half so unreasonably baroque, that he would be happy to understand vanity as an exception and has doubts about it in most cases when people talk of it. For example, he'll say: "I can make a mistake about my own value and yet on the other hand still demand that my value, precisely as I determine it, is recognized by others—that, however, is not vanity (but arrogance or, in the more frequent cases, something called "humility" and "modesty"). Or again, "For many reasons I can take pleasure in the good opinion of others, perhaps because I honour and love them and enjoy all of their pleasures, perhaps also because their good opinion underscores and strengthens the faith I have in my own good opinion of myself, or perhaps because the good opinion of others, even in cases where I do not share it, is still useful to me or promises to be useful—but all that is not vanity." The noble man must first compel himself, particularly with the help of history, to see that since time immemorial, in all the levels of people dependent in some way or other, the common man was only what people thought of him:—not being at all accustomed to set values himself, he measured even himself by no value other than by how his masters assessed him (that is the essential right of masters, to create values). We should understand that, as the consequence of an immense atavism, the common man even today still always waits first for an opinion about himself and then instinctively submits himself to it: however, that is by no means merely to a "good" opinion, but also to a bad and unreasonable one (think, for example, of the greatest part of the self-assessment and self-devaluing which devout women learn from their father confessors and the devout Christian in general learns from his church). Now, in accordance with the slow arrival of the democratic order of things (and its cause, the blood mixing between masters and slaves), the originally noble and rare impulse to ascribe to oneself a value on one's own and "to think well" of oneself will really become more and more encouraged and widespread. But in every moment it has working against it an older, more extensive, and more deeply incorporated tendency—and where the phenomenon of "vanity" is concerned, this older tendency becomes master over the more recent one. The vain person takes pleasure in every good opinion which he hears about himself (quite apart from all considerations of its utility and equally apart from its truth or falsity), just as he suffers from every bad opinion. For he submits to both; he feels himself subjected to them on the basis of that oldest of instincts for submission which breaks out in him. It is "the slave" in the blood of the vain man, a trace of the slave's roguishness—and how much of the "slave" still remains nowadays in woman, for example!—that tries to tempt him into good opinions of himself; in the same way it's the slave who later prostrates himself immediately in front of these opinions, as if he had not summoned them up. —To state the matter once again: vanity is an atavism. 262 A species arises, a

type becomes established and strong, under the long struggle with essentially unchanging, unfavourable conditions. By contrast, we know from the experience of breeders that species which receive an ultra-abundant nourishment and, in general, an increase in protection and care immediately tend towards variety in the type in the strongest manner and are rich in wonders and monstrosities (as well as monstrous vices). Now, let's look at an aristocratic commonwealth—for example, an ancient Greek polis [city state] or Venice—as an organization, whether voluntary or involuntary, for the purpose of breeding. There are men there living together who rely upon one another and who want their species to succeed mainly because it has to succeed or run the fearful risk of being annihilated. Here there is a lack of that advantage, that excess, that protection under which variations are encouraged. The species senses the need for itself as a species, as something which, particularly thanks to its hardness, uniformity, and simplicity of form, can generally succeed and enable itself to keep going in the constant struggles with neighbours or with the rebellious oppressed people or with those who threaten rebellion. The most varied experience teaches them which characteristics they have to thank, above all, for the fact that they are still there, in spite of all the gods and men, that they have always been victorious up to this point. These characteristics they call virtues, and they cultivate only these virtues to any great extent. They do that with severity—in fact, they desire severity. Every aristocratic morality is intolerant in its education of the young, its provisions for women, its marriage customs, its relationships between young and old, and its penal laws (which fix their eyes only on those who are deviants)—it reckons intolerance itself among the virtues, under the name “justice.” A type with few but very strong characteristics, a species of strict, warlike, shrewdly laconic people, close-knit and reserved (and, as such, having the most sophisticated feelings for the charm and nuances of society) in this way establishes itself over and above the changes in the generations. The constant struggle with unvarying, unfavourable conditions is, as mentioned, the factor that makes a type fixed and hard. Finally, however, at some point a fortunate time arises, which lets the immense tension ease. Perhaps there are no more enemies among the neighbours, and the means for living, even for enjoying life, are there in abundance. With one blow the bond and the compulsion of the old discipline are torn apart: that discipline no longer registers as necessary, as a condition of existence—if it wished to remain in existence, it could do so only as a form of luxury, as an archaic taste. Variation, whether as something abnormal (something higher, finer, and rarer) or as degeneration and monstrosity, suddenly bursts onto the scene in the greatest abundance and splendour; the individual dares to be individual and stand apart. At these historical turning points there appear alongside each other and often involved and mixed up together marvellous, multifaceted, jungle-like growths, an upward soaring, a kind

of tropical tempo in competitiveness for growing and an immense annihilation and self-destruction, thanks to the wild egoisms turned against each other and, as it were, exploding, which wrestle with one another “for sun and light” and no longer know how to derive any limit, any restraint, or any consideration from the morality they have had up to that point. This very morality was the one which built up such immense power, which bent the bow in such a threatening manner—now, at this moment, it is and is becoming “outdated.” The dangerous and disturbing point is reached where the greater, more multifaceted, and more comprehensive life lives beyond the old morality; the “individual” stands there, forced to give himself his own laws, his own arts and tricks for self-preservation, self-raising, and self-redemption. Nothing but new what-for’s, nothing but new how-to’s, no common formulas any more, misunderstanding and contempt bound up together, decay, spoilage, and the highest desires tied together in a ghastly way, the genius of the race brimming over from all the horns of plenty with good and bad, an ominous simultaneous presence of spring and autumn, full of new charms and veils, characteristic of young, still unexhausted, still unwearied depravity. Once again there’s danger there, the mother of morality, great danger, this time transferred into the individual, into one’s neighbour and friend, into the alleyways, into one’s own child, into one’s own heart, into all the narrowest and most secret parts of one’s wishes and desires. What will the moral philosophers who emerge at such a time now have to preach? They discover, these keen observers and street loafers, that things are quickly coming to an end, that everything around them is going rotten and spreading corruption, that nothing lasts until the day after tomorrow, except for one kind of person, the incurably mediocre. Only the mediocre have the prospect of succeeding, of reproducing themselves—they are the people of the future, the only survivors, “Be like them! Become mediocre!”—from now on that’s the only morality that still makes sense, that people still hear.—But it is difficult to preach, this morality of mediocrity!—it may never admit what it is and what it wants! It must speak about restraint and worth and duty and love of one’s neighbour—it will have difficulty concealing its irony! 263 There is an instinct for rank which, more than anything, is already an indication of a high rank. There is a delight in the nuances of respect which permits us to surmise a noble origin and habits. The refinement, goodness, and loftiness of a soul are put to a dangerous test when something goes past in front of it which is of the first rank, but which is not yet protected by the fear of authority from prying clutches and crudities: something that goes its way unmarked, undiscovered, tentative, perhaps arbitrarily disguised and hidden, like a living touchstone. The man whose task and practice is to investigate souls will use precisely this art in a number of different forms in order to establish the ultimate value of a soul, the unalterable innate order of rank to which it belongs: he will put it to the test for its instinct of reverence. Différence

engendre haine [Difference engenders hatred]: the nastiness of some natures suddenly spurts out like dirty water when some sacred container, some precious object from a locked shrine, or some book with marks of a great destiny is carried by. On the other hand, there is an involuntary falling silent, a hesitation in the eye, an end to all gestures, things which express that a soul feels close to something most worthy of reverence. The way in which reverence for the Bible in Europe has, on the whole, been maintained so far is perhaps the best piece of discipline and refinement of habits for which Europe owes a debt of thanks to Christianity: such books of profundity and ultimate significance need for their protection an externally imposed tyranny of authority in order to last for those thousands of years necessary to exhaust them and sort out what they mean. Much has been achieved when in the great mass of people (the shallow ones and all sorts of people with diarrhoea) the feeling has finally been cultivated that they are not permitted to touch everything, that there are sacred experiences before which they have to pull off their shoes and which they must keep their dirty hands off—this is almost the highest intensification of their humanity. By contrast, perhaps nothing makes the so-called educated people, those who have faith in “modern ideas,” so nauseating as their lack of shame, the comfortable impudence in their eyes and hands, with which they touch, lick, and grope everything, and it is possible that these days among a people, one still finds in the common folk, particularly among the peasants, more relative nobility of taste and tactful reverence than among the newspaper-reading demi-monde of the spirit, among the educated. 264 One cannot erase from a human being’s soul those actions which his ancestors loved most and carried out most steadfastly: whether they were, for example, industrious savers attached to a writing table and money box, modest and bourgeois in their desires, as well as modest in their virtues, or whether they were accustomed to live giving orders from morning until night, fond of harsh entertainment and, along with that, perhaps of even harsher duties and responsibilities; or whether, finally, they had at some time or other once sacrificed the old privileges of their birth and possessions in order to live entirely for their faith—for their “god”—as men of an unrelenting and delicate conscience, which blushes when confronted with any compromise. It is in no way possible that a man does not possess in his body the characteristics and preferences of his parents and forefathers, no matter what appearance might say to the contrary. This is the problem of race. If we know something about the parents, then we may draw a conclusion about the child: some unpleasant excess or other, some lurking envy, a crude habit of self-justification—these three together have at all times made up the essential type of the rabble—something like that must be passed onto the child as surely as corrupt blood, and with the help of the best education and culture people will succeed only in deceiving others about such heredity. And nowadays what else do education

and culture want! In our age, one very much of the people—I mean to say our uncouth age—“education” and “culture” must basically be the art of deception—to mislead about the origin of the inherited rabble in one’s body and soul. Today an educator who preached truthfulness above everything else and constantly shouted at his students “Be true! Be natural! Act as you really are!”—even such a virtuous and true-hearted jackass would after some time learn to take hold of that furca [pitchfork] of Horace, in order to naturam expellere [drive out nature]. With what success? “Rabble” usque recurret [will always return].(1) 265 At the risk of annoying innocent ears, I propose the following: egoism belongs to the nature of the noble soul; I mean that unshakeable faith that to a being such as “we are” other beings must be subordinate by nature and have to sacrifice themselves. The noble soul takes this fact of its egoism without any question mark and without the feeling that there is anything harsh, compelled, or arbitrary in it, much more as something that may be established in the fundamental law of things. If he sought out a name for this, he would say “It is justice itself.” In some circumstances which make him hesitate at first, he admits that there are those with rights equal to his own. As soon as he has cleared up this question of rank, he moves among these equals who have the same rights as his with the same confident modesty and sophisticated reverence which he has in his dealings with himself—in accordance with an inborn heavenly mechanism which all the stars understand. It is one more part of his egoism, this sophistication and self-restraint in his relations with his equals—every star is such an egoist—: his soul honours itself in them and in the rights which it concedes to them. It has no doubt that the exchange of respect and rights, as the essential quality of all interactions, also belongs to the natural condition of things. The noble soul gives as it takes, out of the passionate and sensitive instinct for repayment, which lies deep within it. The idea “favour” has no sense and agreeable fragrance inter pares [among equals]; there may be a sublime manner of allowing presents from above to wash over one, as it were, and of drinking them up thirstily like water drops, but for these arts and gestures the noble soul has no skill. Here its egoism hinders it: in general, it is not happy to look “up above”—instead it looks either directly forward, horizontally and slowly, or down—it knows that it is on a height. 266 “We can only truly respect highly the man who is not seeking himself” Goethe to Councillor Schlosser. 267 There is a saying among the Chinese that mothers even teach their children: siao-sin, “Make your heart small!” This is the essential and basic tendency of late civilizations: I have no doubt that an ancient Greek would at once recognize this self-diminution in us contemporary Europeans as well—and for that reason alone we would already go “against his taste.” 268 Ultimately, what does it mean to be ignoble?—Words are sound signals for ideas, but ideas are more or less firm image signs for sensations which return frequently and occur together, for groups of sensations. To

understand each other, it is not yet sufficient that people use the same words; they must also use the same words for the same form of inner experiences; in the end they must hold their experience in common with each other. That's why human beings belonging to a single people understand each other better among themselves than associations of different peoples, even when they use the same language; or rather, when human beings have lived together for a long time under similar conditions (climate, soil, danger, needs, work), then something arises out of that which "understands itself"—a people. In all souls, a similar number of frequently repeating experiences have won the upper hand over those which come more rarely; people understand each other on the basis of the former quickly and with ever-increasing speed—the history of language is the history of a process of abbreviation, and on the basis of this rapid understanding, people bind with one another, closely and with ever-increasing closeness. The greater the danger, the greater the need quickly and easily to come to agreement over what needs to be done; not to misunderstand each other when in danger is what people simply cannot do without in their interactions. With every friendship or love affair people still make this test: nothing of that sort lasts as soon as people reach the point where, with the same words, one of the two feels, means, senses, wishes, or fears something different from the other one. (The fear of the "eternal misunderstanding": that is the benevolent genius which so often prevents people of different sexes from over-hasty unions, to which their senses and hearts urge them—and not some Schopenhauerish "genius of the species"!—). Which groups of sensations within the soul wake up most rapidly, seize the word, give the order—that decides about the whole rank ordering of its values, that finally determines its tables of goods. The assessments of value in a man reveal something about the structure of his soul and where it looks for its conditions of life, its essential needs. Now, assume that need has always brought together only such people as could indicate with similar signs similar requirements and similar experiences, then it generally turns out that the easy ability to communicate need, that is, in the last analysis, familiarity with only average and common experiences, must have been the most powerful of all the forces which have so far determined things among human beings. People who are more similar and more ordinary have been and always are at an advantage; the more exceptional, more refined, rarer, and more difficult to understand easily remain isolated; in their isolation they are subject to accidents and rarely propagate themselves. People have to summon up huge counter-forces to check this natural, all-too-natural progressus in simile [advance into similarity], the further development of human beings into what's similar, ordinary, average, herd-like—into what's common. 269 The more a psychologist—a born and inevitable psychologist and diviner of the soul—turns himself towards exceptional examples and human beings, the greater the danger to him of suffocation from

pity. He has to be hard and cheerful, more so than another man. For the corruption and destruction of loftier men, of the stranger type of soul, is the rule: it is terrible to have such a rule always before one's eyes. The multifaceted torment of the psychologist who has uncovered this destructiveness, who once discovers and then almost always rediscovers throughout all history this entire inner "hopelessness" of the loftier people, this eternal "too late!" in every sense—this torment can perhaps one day become the reason he turns with bitterness against his own lot, attempts self-destruction—and "corrupts" himself. With almost every psychologist we will see a revealing inclination for and delight in associating with ordinary and well-adjusted people: that indicates that he always needs healing, that he requires some sort of refuge and forgetting, far from what his insights and incisions, his "trade," have laid on his conscience. Fear of his memory is characteristic of him. He is easily reduced to silence before the judgments of others; he listens with an unmoving face as people revere, admire, love, and transfigure where he has seen, or he even hides his silence, while he expressly agrees with some foreground point of view or other. Perhaps the paradox of his situation gets so terrible that precisely where he has learned great pity as well as great contempt, the crowd, the educated, and the enthusiasts have for their part learned great admiration—the admiration for "great men" and miraculous animals for whose sake people bless and honour the fatherland, the earth, the value of humanity, and themselves, those to whom they draw the attention of the young and whom they use as role models in their education . . . And who knows whether in all great examples up to this point the very same thing has not happened: the crowd worshipped a god—and the "god" was only a poor sacrificial animal! Success has always been the greatest liar, and the "work" itself a success; the great statesman, the conqueror, or the discoverer is disguised in his creation to the point where he is unrecognizable; the "work" of the artist and of the philosopher first invents the man who has created it or is supposed to have created it; the "great men," as they are honoured, are small inferior works of fiction written later; in the world of historical values counterfeit is king. These great poets, for example, this Byron, Musset, Poe, Leopardi, Kleist, Gogol(2)—as they now are and perhaps had to be: men of the moment, enthusiastic, sensuous, childish, careless and sudden with trust and mistrust; with souls in which some fracture or other normally has to be concealed; often taking revenge in their works for an inner slur, often seeking with their flights upward to forget some all-too-true memory, often lost in the mud and almost infatuated, until they become like will o' the wisps around a swamp and pretend that they are stars—then the populace may well call them idealists—often struggling against a long disgust, with a recurring ghost of unbelief which makes them cold and forces them to yearn for gloria [glory] and to feed on "inherent faith" from the hands of intoxicated flatterers—what torture are these great artists and the loftier human

beings in general for the man who has once guessed who they are! It is thus understandable that they should so readily experience from woman—who is clairvoyant in the world of suffering and who unfortunately also seeks to help and to save far beyond her powers—those eruptions of unlimited and most devoted pity which the crowd, above all the worshipping masses, does not understand and which it overwhelms with curious and complacent interpretations. This pity regularly deceives itself about its power; woman may believe that love can do everything—that's a belief essential to her. Alas, anyone who knows about the heart can guess how poor, stupid, helpless, presumptuous, mistaken, more easily destructive than saving even the best and deepest love is! It is possible that beneath the sacred story and charade of the life of Jesus there lies hidden one of the most painful examples of the martyrdom of knowledge about love: the martyrdom of the most innocent and most desiring heart, which was never satisfied with any human love, which demanded love, to be loved and nothing else, with hardness, with madness, with fearful outbreaks against those who denied him love; the history of a poor man unsatisfied and insatiable with love, who had to invent hell in order to send there those who did not wish to love him—and who finally, having grown to understand human love, had to invent a God who is entirely love, who is entirely capable of love—who takes pity on human love because it is so pathetic, so unknowing! Anyone who feels this way, who knows about love in this way—seeks death.—But why dwell on such painful things? Assuming we don't have to.— 270 The spiritual arrogance and disgust of every man who has suffered deeply—how profoundly men can suffer almost determines their order of rank—his chilling certainty, with which he is thoroughly soaked and coloured, that thanks to his suffering he knows more than the cleverest and wisest can know, that he has experienced and at some point been “at home” in many terrible far-off worlds, about which “you know nothing!” . . . this spiritual and silent arrogance of the sufferer, this pride of the one chosen to know, of the “initiate,” of the one who has almost been sacrificed, finds all kinds of disguise necessary to protect itself from contact with prying and compassionate hands and, in general, from everything which is not its equal in pain. Profound suffering ennobles; it separates. One of the most sophisticated forms of disguise is Epicureanism and a certain continuing courageousness in taste adopted as a show, which takes suffering lightly and resists everything sad and deep. There are “cheerful men” who use cheerfulness because it makes them misunderstood—they want to be misunderstood. There are “scientific people” who use science because that provides a cheerful appearance and because being scientific enables one to infer that the person is superficial—they want to seduce people to a false conclusion. There are free, impudent spirits who would like to hide and deny that they are broken, proud, incurable hearts; and now and then even foolishness is a mask for a disastrous, all-too-certain knowledge.(3) Hence,

it follows that it's part of a more sophisticated humanity to have reverence "for the mask" and not to pursue psychology and curiosity in the wrong place. 271 What most profoundly divides two men is a different sense and degree of cleanliness. What help is all honesty and mutual utility, what help is all the good will for each other: in the end the fact remains—they "cannot bear to smell each other!" The highest instinct for cleanliness puts the person marked by it in the strangest and most dangerous isolation, like a saint: for that's simply what saintliness is—the highest spiritualization of the instinct in question. Any awareness of an indescribable abundance of pleasure in the bath, any lust and thirst which constantly drives the soul out of the night into the morning and out of cloudiness, the "affliction," into what is bright, gleaming, profound, and subtle; just as such a tendency singles out—it is a noble tendency—so it also separates. The pity of the saint is pity for the dirt of those who are human, all-too-human. And there are degrees and heights where the saint feels pity itself as contamination, as dirt . . . 272 Signs of nobility: never thinking of reducing our duties to duties for everyone; not wanting to give up one's own responsibility, not wanting to share it; to include our privileges and acting on them among one's duties. 273 A person who strives for something great looks at everyone he meets along his way either as a means or as a delay and an obstacle—or as a temporary place to rest. His characteristic high-quality goodness towards his fellow men is first possible when he has reached his height and governs. His impatience and his awareness that until that point he is always sentenced to comedy—for even war is a comedy and conceals, just as every means hides the end—corrupt all contacts for him: this kind of man knows loneliness and what is most poisonous in it. 274 The problem of those who wait. —For a higher man in whom the solution to a problem lies asleep, strokes of luck and all sorts of unpredictable things are necessary for him to swing into action at just the right time—"for an eruption," as we could say. Ordinarily it does not happen, and in all the corners of the earth people sit waiting, who hardly know to what extent they are waiting, but even less that they are waiting in vain. From time to time the call to wake up, that chance which provides "permission" for action, comes too late—at a time when their best youth and power for action have already been used up in sitting still. And many a man, in the very moment he "sprang up," has found to his horror that his limbs have gone to sleep and his spirit is already too heavy! "It is too late," he has said to himself, having lost faith in himself, and is now forever useless. —In the realm of genius, could "Raphael without hands," taking that phrase in the widest sense, perhaps not be the exception but the rule?(4)—Genius is perhaps not really so rare, but rather the five hundred hands needed to tyrannize the kairos, "the right time," to seize chance by the forelock!(5) 275 Anyone who does not want to see the height of a man looks all the more keenly at what is low and in his foreground—and in the

process gives himself away. 276 With all kinds of injury and loss the lower and cruder soul is better off than the more noble one: the dangers for the latter must be greater; the probability that it will go wrong and die is even immense, given the multifaceted nature of its living conditions.—With a lizard a finger which has been lost grows back: not so with a man. 277 Bad enough! The old story again! When we have finished building our house, we suddenly notice that in the process we have learned something that we simply had to know before we started to build. The eternally tiresome “Too late!”—The melancholy of everything finished! . . . 278 Wanderer, who are you? I see you going on your way, without scorn, without love, with unfathomable eyes, damp and sad, like a lead sinker which has come back unsatisfied from every depth into the light—what was it looking for down there?—with a breast which does not sigh, with a lip which hides its disgust, with a hand which grasps only slowly: Who are you? What have you been doing? Have a rest here: this place is hospitable to everyone—relax! And whoever you happen to be, what would you like now? What do you need to recuperate? Just name it: what I have I’ll offer you! “For relaxation? For recuperation? O you inquisitive man, what are you talking about! But give me, I beg . . .” What? What? Say it!—“One more mask! A second mask!” . . . 279 Men of profound sorrow betray themselves when they are happy: they have a way of grabbing happiness as if they would like to overwhelm and strangle it from jealousy—alas, they know too well that it is running away from them! 280 “Bad! Bad! What? Is he not going—back?”—Yes! But you understand him badly if you complain about it. He’s going back, as every man does who wants to make a huge jump.— 281 “Will people believe it of me? But I demand that people believe it of me: I have always thought only badly of myself and about myself, only in very rare cases, only when under compulsion, always without delight ‘for the subject,’ ready to wander off from ‘myself,’ always without faith in the conclusion, thanks to the uncontrollable mistrust of the possibility of self-knowledge, which has taken me so far that I find even the idea of ‘immediate knowledge,’ which the theoreticians allow themselves, a *contradictio in adjecto* [contradiction in terms]: this entire fact is almost the surest thing I know about myself. Within me there must be some kind of aversion to believing anything definite about myself. Is a riddle perhaps hidden in that? Probably, but fortunately nothing for my own teeth. Perhaps it reveals the species to which I belong?—But not to me: and that’s enough to satisfy me. 282 “But what has happened to you?”—“I don’t know,” he said, hesitating; “perhaps the Harpies have flown over my table.”(6) Occasionally nowadays it happens that a mild, moderate, reserved man suddenly becomes violent, smashes plates, throws over the table, screams, stomps around, slanders the entire world—and finally turns aside, ashamed, furious with himself.—Where? What for? To starve off on his own? To suffocate on his memory? Anyone who has the desires of a lofty,

discriminating soul and only rarely finds his table set and his nourishment ready will at all times be in great danger: but today the danger is extraordinary. Thrown into a noisy and uncouth age, with which he does not want to eat out of the same dish, he can easily perish from hunger and thirst, or, if he finally nonetheless “helps himself,”—from sudden disgust.—All of us have probably already sat at tables where we did not belong; and it’s precisely the most spiritual ones among us who are the most difficult to feed, who know that dangerous dyspepsia which comes from a sudden insight and disappointment about our food and those sitting next to us at the table—the after-dinner disgust. 283 Assuming that one wants to praise at all, there’s a refined and at the same time noble self-control that always gives praise only where one does not agree:—in other cases one would really be praising oneself, something that contradicts good taste—naturally, a self-control which provides a good opportunity and provocation for one to be constantly misunderstood. In order to permit oneself this true luxury of taste and morality, one must not live among spiritual fools, but rather among people whose misunderstandings and false ideas are still amusing for their sophistication—or one will have to pay dearly for it!—“He is praising me: thus, he admits I’m right”—this asinine way of making conclusions ruins half of life for us hermits, for it brings the asses into our neighbourhood and friendship. 284 To live with an immense and proud composure: always beyond.—To have and not have one’s feelings, one’s for and against, voluntarily, to condescend to them for hours, to sit on them, as if on a horse, often as if on a donkey:—for one needs to know how to use their stupidity as well as their fire. To preserve one’s three hundred foregrounds and one’s dark glasses: for there are occasions when no one should be allowed to look into our eyes, even less into our “reasons.” And to select for company that mischievous and cheerful vice, courtesy. And to remain master of one’s four virtues: courage, insight, sympathy, and solitude. For solitude is a virtue with us, as a sublime tendency and impulse for cleanliness, which senses how contact between one person and another—“in society”—must inevitably bring impurity with it. Every community somehow, somewhere, sometime makes people—“common.” 285 The greatest events and ideas—but the greatest ideas are the greatest events—are understood last of all: the generations contemporary with them do not experience such events—they go on living past them. What happens then is something like in the realm of the stars. The light of the most distant stars comes to men last of all: and before that light arrives, men deny that there are stars there. “How many centuries does a spirit need in order to be understood?”—that is also a standard with which people construct a rank ordering and etiquette, as is necessary, for spirit and star.— 286 “Here the view is free, the spirit elevated.”—But there is a reverse kind of person who is also on the heights and also has a free view—but who looks down. 287 What is noble? What does the word “noble” still mean to us nowadays? What reveals the noble

human being, how do people recognize him, under this heavy, oppressive sky at the beginning of the rule of the rabble, which is making everything opaque and leaden?—It is not the actions that prove him—actions are always ambiguous, always inscrutable—; nor is it the “works.” Among artists and scholars today we find a sufficient number of those who through their works reveal how a profound desire for what is noble drives them: but this very need for what is noble is fundamentally different from the needs of the noble soul itself and is really the eloquent and dangerous indication that such a soul is lacking. It’s not the works; it’s the belief which decides here, which here establishes the order of rank, to take up once more an old religious formula with a new and more profound meaning: some basic certainty that a noble soul has about itself, something that does not allow itself to be sought out or found or perhaps even to be lost. The noble soul has reverence for itself.— 288 There are human beings who have spirit in an inevitable way. They may toss and turn as they wish and hold their hands in front of their tell-tale eyes (—as if the hand were not a giveaway!—): finally it always comes out that they have something they are hiding, that is, spirit. One of the most sophisticated ways to deceive, at least for as long as possible, and to present oneself successfully as stupider than one is—what in common life is often as desirable as an umbrella—is called enthusiasm, including what belongs with it, for example, virtue. For, as Galiani, who must have known, says: *vertu est enthousiasme* [virtue is enthusiasm]. 289 In the writings of a hermit we always hear something of the echo of a wasteland, something of the whispers and the timid gazing around of isolation; from his strongest words, even from his crying out, still resounds a new and more dangerous kind of silence, of concealment. Whoever has sat down, year in and year out, day and night, alone in an intimate dispute and conversation with his soul, whoever has become a cave bear or digger for treasure or guardian of treasure and dragon in his own cavern—it can be a labyrinth but also a gold mine—such a man’s very ideas finally take on a distinct twilight colouring and smell as much of mould as they do of profundity, something uncommunicative and reluctant, which blows cold wind over everyone passing by. The hermit does not believe that a philosopher—assuming that a philosopher has always first been a hermit—has ever expressed his real and final opinions in his books. Don’t people write books expressly to hide what they have stored inside them?—In fact, he will have doubts whether a philosopher could generally have “real and final” opinions, whether in his case behind every cave there does not lie, and must lie, an even deeper cavern—a more comprehensive, stranger, richer world beyond the surface, an abyss behind every ground, under every “foundation.” Every philosophy is a foreground philosophy—that is the judgment of a hermit: “There is something arbitrary about the fact that he remained here, looked back, and looked around, that at this point set his shovel aside and did not dig more deeply

—there is also something suspicious about it.” Every philosophy also hides a philosophy; every opinion is also a hiding place, every word is also a mask. 290 Every deep thinker is more afraid of being understood than of being misunderstood. In the latter case, perhaps his vanity suffers, but the former hurts his heart, his sympathy, which always says, “Alas, why do you want to have it as hard as I did?” 291 Man, a multifaceted, lying, artificial, and impenetrable animal, who spooks other animals less by his power than by his cunning and intelligence, has invented good conscience in order to enjoy his own soul for once as something simple; and all of morality is a long spirited falsification, thanks to which it’s at all possible to enjoy looking at the soul. From this point of view, perhaps much more belongs to the idea of “art” than people commonly believe. 292 A philosopher: that is a man who constantly experiences, sees, hears, suspects, hopes, and dreams extraordinary things; who is struck by his very own thoughts as if from outside, as if from above and below, as if they are events and lightning strikes tailor-made for him; who is himself perhaps a storm which moves along pregnant with new lightning flashes; a fateful man, around whom things always rumble and mutter and gape and proceed mysteriously. A philosopher: alas, a being that often runs away from himself, is often afraid of himself—but that is too curious not to “come back to himself” again and again. . . . 293 A man who says, “That pleases me. I take that for my own and will protect it and defend it against everyone,” a man who can lead a cause, put a decision into effect, remain true to an idea, hold on to a woman, punish and cast down an insolent person, a man who has his anger and his sword and to whom the weak, the suffering, the distressed, and even the animals are happy to go and belong to by nature—in short, a man who is naturally a master—when such a man has pity, well, this pity is worth something! But what is there in the pity of those who suffer! Or even of those who preach pity! Today in almost all of Europe there is a pathological susceptibility and sensitivity to pain, as well as a nasty lack of restraint in complaining, a mollycoddling, which likes to dress itself up with religion and philosophical bits and pieces as something loftier—there is a formal culture of suffering. In my view, the unmanliness of what is christened “pity” in such enthusiastic circles is what always strikes the eye first.—We must excommunicate this latest form of bad taste, powerfully and thoroughly; and finally I wish that people would set against their hearts and throats the good amulet “gai saber,”—“gay science,” to clarify this matter for the Germans. 294 The Olympian vice.—In spite of that philosopher who, as a genuine Englishman, tried to make laughing a defamation of character among all thinking men —“Laughter is a serious infirmity of human nature, which every thinking man will strive to overcome” (Hobbes)—I would really allow myself to order the ranks of philosophers according to the rank of their laughter—right up to those who are capable of golden laughter. And assuming that the gods also practise

philosophy, a fact which many conclusions have already driven me to—I don't doubt that in the process they also know how to laugh in a superhuman and new way—and at the expense of all serious things! Gods delight in making fun: even where sacred actions are concerned, it seems they cannot stop laughing. 295 The genius of the heart, as that great hidden presence possesses it, the tempter-god and born pried piper of the conscience, whose voice knows how to climb down into the underworld of every soul, who does not say a word or cast a glance in which there does not lie some concern with and trace of temptation, whose mastery includes the fact that he understands how to seem—and not what he is, but what for those who follow him is one more compulsion to press themselves always closer to him, to follow him ever more inwardly and completely:—that genius of the heart who makes all noise and self-satisfaction fall silent and teaches it to listen, who smoothes out the rough souls and gives them a new desire to taste,—to lie still as a mirror so that the deep heaven reflects itself in them—; the genius of the heart who teaches the foolish and over-hasty hand to hesitate and reach out more delicately; who senses the hidden and forgotten treasure, the drop of goodness and sweet spirituality under the thick cloudy ice and is a divining rod for every grain of gold that has lain buried a long time in a dungeon crammed with mud and sand; the genius of the heart, at whose touch everyone goes forward richer, not divinely gifted and surprised, not as if delighted and oppressed with some foreign good, but richer in his own self, newer to himself than previously, broken open, blown upon and sounded out by a thawing wind, more uncertain perhaps, more tender, more fragile, more broken, but full of hopes that as yet have no names, full of new will and flowing, full of new irritations and opposing currents . . . But what am I doing, my friends? Whom am I speaking to you about? Have I forgotten myself so much that I have not once named him to you? Unless you have already guessed for yourselves who this questionable spirit and god is who wants to be praised in such a way. For just as things go with anyone who from the time he walked on childish legs has always been on the move and in alien territory, so many strange and not undangerous spirits have crossed my path, too, above all the one I have just been speaking about, who has come again and again, namely, no less a spirit than the god Dionysus, that enormously ambiguous and tempter god, to whom in earlier times, as you know, I offered up my first born, in all secrecy and reverence—as the last person, so I thought, who had offered a sacrifice to him: for I found no one who understood what I was doing then.(7) Meanwhile I learned a great deal, much too much, about the philosophy of this god, and, as mentioned, from mouth to mouth—I, the last disciple and initiate of the god Dionysus: and perhaps I can at last begin to give you, my friends, a little taste of this philosophy, as much as I am permitted? In a hushed voice, as is reasonable, for this concerns a number of things that are secret, new, strange, odd, and mysterious. Even the fact that

Dionysus is a philosopher and that the gods also carry on philosophy seems to me a novelty that is not harmless and that perhaps might excite mistrust precisely among philosophers—among you, my friends it has less against it, although it could be that it comes too late and not at the right moment: for it has been revealed to me that nowadays you are not happy to believe in god and gods. Also perhaps the fact that in my explanation I must proceed with more candour than is always pleasing to the strict habits of your ears? Certainly the god under discussion went further, very much further, in conversations like this and was always several steps ahead of me . . . In fact, if it were permitted, I would, following human practices, attach to him beautifully solemn names of splendour and virtue; I would have to lavish a great deal of praise on him for his courage as an explorer and discoverer, for his daring honesty, truthfulness, and love of wisdom. But such a god has no idea how to begin with all this venerable rubbish and pageantry. “Keep that,” he would say, “for yourself and people like you and anyone else who needs it! I have no reason to cover my nakedness!”—Do people sense that this type of divinity and philosopher perhaps lacks shame? He said it this way once, “In some circumstances, I love human beings”—and in saying that, he was alluding to Ariadne, who was present—“for me a human being is a pleasant, brave, inventive animal that has no equal on earth; it finds the right path even in every labyrinth.”(8) I like him: I often reflect how I could bring him further forwards and make him stronger, more evil, and more profound than he is.”—“Stronger, more evil, and more profound?” I asked shocked. “Yes,” he said once more, “stronger, more evil, and more profound, also more beautiful”—and with that the tempter god smiled with his halcyon smile, as if he had just uttered an enchanting compliment. We see here also that it is not just shame this divinity lacks—; and in general there are good reasons to suppose that in some things the gods collectively could learn from us human beings. We human beings are—more human. . . 296 Alas, what are you then, my written and painted thoughts! It’s not so long ago that you were still so colourful, young, and malicious, full of stings and secret seasonings, that you made me sneeze and laugh.—And now? You have already stripped off your novelty and some of you, I fear, are ready to become truths: you already look so immortal, so heartbreakingly honest, so boring! And was it ever different? What things we transcribe in our writing and painting, we mandarins with a Chinese brush, we immortalizers of things which let themselves be written—what are the only things we are capable of painting? Alas, only what is about to fade and is beginning to lose its fragrance! Alas, only storms which are worn out and withdrawing and old yellow feelings! Alas, only birds which have exhausted themselves flying and lost their way and now let themselves be caught by hand—by our hand! We immortalize what can no longer live and fly, only tired and crumbling things! And it is only your afternoon, my written and painted thoughts, for which I alone have colours,

many colours perhaps, many colourful caresses and fifty yellows and browns and greens and reds:—but no one will sense from me how you looked in your dawn, you sudden sparks and miracles of my solitude, you, my old loved ones—my wicked thoughts! NOTES (1) Quintus Horatius Flaccus (65-8 BC) an important poet in classical Rome. [Back to Text] (2) The 1900 German edition adds here: “(I don’t dare mention greater names, but I have them in mind). [Back to Text] (3) The German edition of 1900 adds after the words “incurable hearts” the parenthetic comment: “(the cynicism of Hamlet, the case of Galiani).” [Back to Text] (4) Raphael (1483-1520): major Italian painter of the Renaissance. [Back to Text] (5) Nietzsche uses Greek letters here: καίρός. [Back to Text] (6) Harpies: mythological winged monsters who steal food. [Back to Text] (7) The “first work” Nietzsche is referring to is his *Birth of Tragedy*, published in 1872, in which he proposes the struggle between the Apollonian and Dionysian. [Back to Text] (8) Ariadne: in Greek mythology the daughter of Minos, king of Crete. She helped Theseus kill the Minotaur in the Labyrinth and escaped with him. When Theseus abandoned Ariadne, Dionysus fell in love with her. [Back to Text]

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 === End of Beyond Good and Evil (translated by Ian Johnston)
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Part VIII

On the Genealogy of Morals

1887 — Translated by Ian Johnston

Nietzsche, Genealogy of Morals, Prologue Friedrich Nietzsche On the Genealogy of Morals A Polemical Tract Translated by Ian Johnston, Vancouver Island University Nanaimo, British Columbia, Canada [For information on copyright and publication details, please use the following link: [Genealogy, Table of Contents](#). For a Rich Text Format version of this text, please use the following link: [Prologue. \[RTF\]](#), For a PDF file of the entire text of the Genealogy, use the following link ([Genealogy, PDF](#)) Prologue 1 We don't know ourselves, we knowledgeable people—we are personally ignorant about ourselves. And there's good reason for that. We've never looked for ourselves—how could it happen that one day we'd discover ourselves? With justice it's been said, "Where your treasure is, there shall your heart be also."⁽¹⁾ Our treasure lies where the beehives of our knowledge stand. We are always busy with our knowledge, as born winged creatures and collectors of intellectual honey. In our hearts we are concerned with really only one thing—to "bring something home." As far as the rest of life is concerned, what people call "experiences,"—who of us is serious enough for that? Or has enough time? In these matters, I fear, we've been "missing the point." Our hearts have simply not been engaged with that—nor, for that matter, have our ears! Instead we've been more like someone divinely distracted and self-absorbed into whose ear the clock has just pealed the twelve strokes of noon with all its force and who all at once wakes up and asks himself "What exactly did that clock strike?"—so now and then we even rub our ears afterwards and ask, totally surprised and completely embarrassed— "What have we really just experienced?" And more: "Who are we really?" Then, as I've mentioned, we count—after the fact—all the twelve trembling strokes of the clock of our experience, of our lives, of our being—alas! in the process we keep losing count . . . We remain simply and necessarily strangers to ourselves, we do not understand ourselves, we must be confused about ourselves. For us this proposition holds for all eternity: "Each man is furthest from himself"—where we ourselves are concerned, we are not "knowledgeable people" . . . 2 My thoughts about the origin of our moral prejudices—for this polemical tract is concerned about that origin—had their first brief, provisional expression in that collection of aphorisms which carried the title *Human, All-too Human: A Book for Free Spirits*, which I started to write in Sorrento, during a winter when I had

the chance to pause, just as a traveller stops, and to look over the wide and dangerous land through which my spirit had wandered up to that point. This happened in the winter of 1876-77, but the ideas themselves are older. In the main points, they were already the same ideas which I am taking up again in the present essays:—let's hope that the long interval of time has done them some good, that they have become ripier, brighter, stronger, and more complete! But the fact that today I still stand by these ideas, that in the intervening time they themselves have constantly become more strongly associated with one another, in fact, have grown into each other and intertwined, that reinforces in me the joyful confidence that they may not have originally developed in me as single, random, or sporadic ideas, but up out of a common root, out of a fundamental will for knowledge ruling from deep within, always speaking with greater clarity, always demanding greater clarity. For that's the only thing appropriate to a philosopher. We have no right to be isolated in any way: we are not permitted either to make isolated mistakes or to run into truths in isolation. By contrast, our ideas, our values, our affirmations and denials, our if's and whether's grow out of us from the same necessity which makes a tree bear its fruit—totally related and interlinked amongst each other, witnesses of one will, one health, one soil, one sun.—As for the question whether these fruits of ours taste good to you—what does that matter to the trees! What concern is that to us, we philosophers! 3

Because of a doubt peculiar to my own nature, which I am reluctant to confess—for it concerns itself with morality, with everything which up to the present has been celebrated on earth as morality—a doubt which came into my life so early, so uninvited, so irresistibly, in such contradiction to my surroundings, my age, precedent, and my origin, that I would almost have the right to call it my “a priori [before experience]—because of this, my curiosity as well as my suspicion had to pause early on at the question of where our good and evil really originated. In fact, already as a thirteen-year-old lad, my mind was occupying itself with the problem of the origin of evil. At an age when one has “half children's play, half God in one's heart,” I devoted my first childish literary trifle, my first written philosophical exercise, to this problem—and so far as my “solution” to it at that time is concerned, well, I gave the honour to God, as is reasonable, and made him the father of evil. Is that precisely what my “a priori” demanded of me, that new immoral, at the very least unmoral “a priori” and the “categorical imperative” which spoke out from it, alas, so anti-Kantian and so cryptic, which I have increasingly listened to ever since—and not just listened to?(2) Luckily at an early stage I learned to separate theological prejudices from moral ones, and I no longer sought the origin of evil behind the world. Some education in history and philology, along with an inherently refined sense concerning psychological questions in general, quickly changed my problem into something else: Under what conditions did people invent for themselves those

value judgments good and evil? And what value do they inherently possess? Have they hindered or fostered human wellbeing up to now? Are they a sign of some emergency, of impoverishment, of an atrophying life? Or is it the other way around? Do they indicate fullness, power, a will for life, its courage, its confidence, its future? To these questions I came across and proposed all sorts of answers for myself. I distinguished between ages, peoples, and different ranks of individuals. I kept refining my problem. Out of the answers arose new questions, investigations, assumptions, and probabilities, until at last I had my own country, my own soil, a totally secluded, flowering, blooming world, a secret garden, as it were, of which no one could have the slightest inkling. O how lucky we are, we knowledgeable people, provided only that we know how to stay silent long enough! 4 The initial stimulus to publish something of my hypotheses concerning the origin of morality was given to me by a lucid, tidy, clever, even precocious little book, in which for the first time I clearly ran into a topsy-turvy, perverse type of genealogical hypotheses—a genuinely English style. It drew me with that power of attraction that everything opposite, everything antipodal, contains. The title of this booklet was *The Origin of the Moral Feelings*, its author was Dr Paul Rée, and it appeared in the year 1877.(3) I have perhaps never read anything which I would have denied, statement by statement, conclusion by conclusion, as I did with this book, but entirely without any annoyance or impatience. In the work I mentioned above, with which I was engaged at the time, I made opportune and inopportune references to statements in Dr. Rée’s book, not in order to prove them wrong—what have I to do with preparing refutations!—but, as is appropriate to a positive spirit, to put in the place of something unlikely something more likely and, in some circumstances, in the place of some error another error. In that period, as I said, for the first time I brought into the light of day those hypotheses about genealogy to which these essays have been dedicated—but clumsily, as I myself would be the last to deny, still fettered, still without my own language for these concerns of mine, and with all sorts of retreating and vacillating. For particular details, you should compare what I say in *Human, All-too Human*, p. 51 [Section 45], about the double nature of the prehistory of good and evil (that is, in the spheres of the nobility and the slaves); similarly, pages 119 ff. [Section 136], concerning the worth and origin of ascetic morality, as well as pages 78, 82, and II, 35 [Sections 96, 99, and Volume II, Section 89] concerning the “Morality of Custom,” that much older and more primitive style of morality, which lies *toto coelo* [by all the heavens, i.e., absolutely] from the altruistic way of valuing (which Dr. Rée, like all English genealogists of morality, sees as the very essence of moral evaluation); similarly, page 74 [Section 1.92](T); *Wanderer*, page 29 [Section 26]; and *Daybreak*, page 99 [Section 112], concerning the origin of justice as a compromise between approximately equal powers (equality as precondition of all contracts and

therefore of all law); likewise concerning the origin of punishment in *Wanderer*, pages 25 and 34 [Sections 22 and 33], for which an intent to terrify is neither essential nor original (as Dr. Rée claims:—it is far more likely first brought in under a specific set of conditions and always as something incidental, something additional).(4) 5 Basically at that point the real concern for me at heart was something much more important than coming up with the nature of hypotheses about the origin of morality, either my own or from other people (or, more precisely stated—this latter issue was important to me only for the sake of a goal to which it is one way out of many). For me the issue was the value of morality—and in that matter I had to take issue almost alone with my great teacher Schopenhauer, the one to whom, as if to a contemporary, that book, with its passion and hidden contradiction, addresses itself (—for it, too, was a “polemical tract”).(5) The most specific issue was the worth of the “unegoistic,” of the instincts for pity, for self-denial, and for self-sacrifice, of things which Schopenhauer himself had painted with gold, deified, and projected into another world [*verjenseitigt*] for so long that they finally remained for him “value as such” and the reason why he said No to life and even to himself, as well. But a constantly more fundamental suspicion of these very instincts voiced itself in me, a scepticism which always dug deeper! It was precisely here that I saw the great danger to humanity, its most sublime temptation and seduction.—But in what direction? To nothingness?—It was precisely here I saw the beginning of the end, the standing still, the backward-glancing exhaustion, the will turning itself against life, the final illness tenderly and sadly announcing itself. I understood the morality of pity, which was always seizing more and more around it and which gripped even the philosophers and made them sick, as the most sinister symptom of our European culture, which itself had become sinister, as its detour to a new Buddhism? to a European Buddhism? to—nihilism? . . . This modern philosophical preference for and overvaluing of pity is really something new. Concerning the worthlessness of pity, philosophers up to now have been in agreement. I cite only Plato, Spinoza, La Rochefoucauld, and Kant—four spirits as different from one another as possible, but united in one thing, in the low value they set on pity.—(6) 6 This problem of the value of pity and of the morality of pity (—I’m an opponent of the disgraceful modern effeminacy of feeling—) appears at first to be only something isolated, a detached question mark. But anyone who remains here for a while and learns to ask questions will experience what happened to me:—a huge new vista opens up before him, a possibility grips him like an attack of dizziness, every kind of mistrust, suspicion, and fear springs up, his belief in morality, in all morality, totters—and finally he recognizes a new demand. Let’s proclaim this new demand: we need a critique of moral values, we must first question the very value of these values—and for that we need a knowledge of the conditions and circumstances out of which these

values grew, under which they have developed and changed (morality as consequence, as symptom, as mask, as Tartufferie [hypocrisy], as illness, as misunderstanding, but also morality as cause, as means of healing, as stimulant, as scruple, as poison), a knowledge of a sort that has not been there up to this point, that has not even been wished for. We have taken the worth of these “values” as given, as self-evident, as beyond all dispute. Up until now people have not even had the slightest doubts about or wavered in setting up “the good man” as more valuable than “the evil man,” of higher worth in the sense of improvement, usefulness, and prosperity with respect to mankind in general (along with the future of humanity). What about this? What if the truth were the other way around? Well? What if in the “good man” there even lay a symptom of regression, like a danger, a seduction, a poison, a narcotic, something which, for example, made the present live at the cost of the future? Perhaps in greater comfort and less danger, but also on a smaller scale and in a more demeaning way? . . . So that morality itself would be guilty if the inherently possible highest power and magnificence of the human type were never attained? So that morality itself might be the danger of dangers? . . . 7 Suffice it to say that once this insight revealed itself to me, I had reasons to look around me for learned, bold, and hard-working comrades (today I’m still searching). It’s a matter of travelling through the immense, distant, and so secretive land of morality—morality which has really existed, which has really been lived—with nothing but new questions and, as it were, with new eyes. Isn’t that almost like discovering this land for the first time? . . . In this matter, it so happened that, among others I thought of, the above-mentioned Dr. Rée, because I had no doubts at all that by the very nature of his questions he would be driven on his own to a more correct methodology in order to arrive at any answers. Did I deceive myself in this? At any rate, my desire was to provide a better direction for such a keen and objective eye as his, a direction leading to a true history of morality, and to advise him in time against such an English way of making hypotheses into the blue. For, indeed, it’s obvious which colour must be a hundred times more important for a genealogist of morality than this blue: namely, gray, in other words, what has been documented, what can be established as the truth, what really took place, in short, the long and difficult-to-decipher hieroglyphic writing of the past in human morality.—This was unknown to Dr. Rée. But he had read Darwin:—and so to some extent in his hypotheses the Darwinian beast and the most modern modest and tender moral sensibility, which “no longer bites,” politely extend their hands to each other in a way that is at least entertaining—with the latter bearing a facial expression revealing a certain good-natured and refined indolence, in which is even mixed a grain of pessimism and exhaustion, as if it is really not worth taking all these things—the problems of morality—so seriously. (7) But for me things appear reversed: there are no issues at all which provide

more incentives to take them seriously; among the rewards, for example, is the fact that one day perhaps people will be permitted to take them cheerfully. For cheerfulness, or, to say it in my own language, the gay science, is a reward, a reward for a lengthy, brave, hard-working, and underground seriousness, which, of course, is not something for everyone. But on that day when, from full hearts, we say “Forward! Our old morality also belongs in a comedy!” we’ll have discovered a new complication and possibility for the Dionysian drama of “the fate of the soul”:—and we can bet that he will put it to good use, the grand old immortal comic poet of our existence! . . . 8 If this writing is incomprehensible to someone or other and hurts his ears, the blame for that, it strikes me, is not necessarily mine. The writing is sufficiently clear given the conditions I assume—that people have first read my earlier writings and have taken some trouble to do so, for, in fact, these works are not easily accessible. For example, so far as my Zarathustra is concerned, I don’t consider anyone knowledgeable about it who has not at some time or another been deeply wounded by and profoundly delighted with every word in it.(8) For only then can he enjoy the privilege of sharing with reverence the halcyon element out of which that work was born, its sunny clarity, distance, breadth, and certainty. In other cases the aphoristic form creates difficulties. These stem from the fact that nowadays people do not take this form seriously enough. An aphorism, properly stamped and poured, has not yet been “deciphered” simply by being read. It’s much more the case that only now can one begin to explicate it, and that requires an art of interpretation. In the third essay of this book I have set out a model of what I call an “interpretation” for such a case.—In this essay an aphorism is presented, and the essay itself is a commentary on it. Of course, in order to practice this style of reading as art, one thing is above all essential, something that today especially has been preferably forgotten—and so it will require still more time before my writings are “readable”—something for which one almost needs to be a cow, at any rate not a “modern man”—rumination. Sils-Maria, Oberengadin July 1887

ENDNOTES

(1) The quotation is from Matthew 6.21. [Back to Text] (2) a priori: This phrase refers to some idea or capacity one possesses inherently, something not provided by experience (like the ability to reason without taking the senses into account). The phrase is commonly associated with the theories of Immanuel Kant (1724-1804) the great German philosopher; categorical imperative: the key phrase in Kant’s morality, the idea that moral action consists of acting upon a principle which could become a rational moral principle without creating a moral contradiction (“Act so that the maxim [which determines your will] may be capable of becoming a universal law for all rational beings”). [Back to Text] (3) Paul Rée (1849-1901): a German philosopher and friend of Nietzsche’s. [Back to Text] (4) *Human, All-too Human* was published in 1878, *Wanderer* in 1880 and *Daybreak* (or *Dawn*) in 1881. [Back to Text] (5) Arthur Schopenhauer

(1788-1860): German philosopher, whose work exercised a significant influence on Nietzsche, especially his emphasis on the importance of the human will. [Back to Text] (6) Plato (428-348 BC): the most important of the classical Greek philosophers; Baruch de Spinoza (1632-1677): Dutch philosopher; Francois de La Rochefoucauld (1613-1680): French author, famous for his maxims. [Back to Text] (7) Charles Darwin (1809-1882): English natural scientist whose *Origin of Species* was published in 1859. [Back to Text] (8) Nietzsche's *Thus Spake Zarathustra* was written between 1883 and 1885. [Back to Text] [Back to Genealogy of Morals, Table of Contents] [Link to Genealogy, Essay One] Nietzsche, *Genealogy of Morals*, Essay 1 Friedrich Nietzsche *On the Genealogy of Morals A Polemical Tract* Translated by Ian Johnston Vancouver Island University Nanaimo, British Columbia 2014 [Students, teachers, artists, and members of the general public may download and distribute this text free of charge and without permission. They may also freely edit the text to suit their purposes. However, no commercial publication of this text or any part of it is permitted without permission of the translator. For any questions or comments please contact Ian Johnston. Note that in the following text, the words within square brackets have been added by the translator. The numbers in curved brackets indicate links to explanatory endnotes provided by the translator.] If you would like to download a Rich Text Format (Word) text of this text, please use the following link: [Genealogy 1 \[RTF\] First Essay Good and Evil, Good and Bad 1](#) —These English psychologists, whom we have to thank for the only attempts up to this point to produce a history of the origins of morality—in themselves they serve up to us no small riddle. By way of a living riddle, they even offer, I confess, something substantially more than their books—they are interesting in themselves! These English psychologists—what do they really want? We find them, willingly or unwillingly, always at the same work, that is, shoving the *partie honteuse* [shameful part] of our inner world into the foreground and looking for the truly effective and operative factor which has determined our development in the very place where man's intellectual pride would least wish to find it (for example, in the *vis inertiae* [force of inertia] of habit or in forgetfulness or in a blind, contingent, mechanical joining of ideas or in something purely passive, automatic, reflex, molecular, and fundamentally stupid)—what is it that really drives these psychologists always in this particular direction? Is it a secret, malicious, and common instinct, perhaps one which cannot be acknowledged even to itself, for belittling humanity? Or something like a pessimistic suspicion, the mistrust of idealists who've become disappointed, gloomy, venomous, and green? Or a small underground hostility and rancune [rancour] towards Christianity (and Plato), which perhaps has never once managed to cross the threshold of consciousness? Or even a lecherous taste for what is odd or painfully paradoxical, for what in existence is questionable

and ridiculous? Or finally—a bit of all of these: a little vulgarity, a little gloominess, a little hostility to Christianity, a little thrill, and a need for pepper? . . . But I'm told that these men are simply old, cold, boring frogs, who creep and hop around and into people, as if they were in their own proper element, that is, in a swamp. I resist that idea when I hear it. What's more, I don't believe it. And if one is permitted to hope where one cannot know, then I hope from my heart that the situation with these men might be reversed, that these investigators and the ones peering at the soul through their microscopes may be thoroughly brave, generous, and proud animals, who know how to control their hearts and their pain and who at the same time have educated themselves to sacrifice all desirability for the sake of the truth, for the sake of every truth, even the simple, bitter, hateful, repellent, unchristian, immoral truth. . . . For there are such truths. — 2 So all respect to the good spirits that may govern in these historians of morality! But it's certainly a pity that they lack the historical spirit, that they've been left in the lurch especially by all the good spirits of history itself! As a group they all think essentially unhistorically, in what is now the traditional manner of philosophers. Of that there is no doubt. The incompetence of their genealogies of morals reveals itself at the very beginning, where the issue is to determine the origin of the idea and of the judgment "good." "People," so they proclaim, "originally praised unegoistic actions and called them good from the perspective of those for whom they were done, that is, those for whom such actions were useful. Later people forgot how this praise began, and simply because unegoistic actions had, according to custom, always been praised as good, people also felt them as good—as if they were something inherently good." We perceive right away that this initial derivation already contains all the typical characteristics idiosyncrasies of English psychologists—we have "usefulness," "forgetting," "habit," and finally "error," all as the foundation for an evaluation in which the higher man up to this time has taken pride, as if it were a sort of privilege of men generally. This pride is to be humbled, this evaluation of worth emptied of value. Has that been achieved? . . . Now, first of all, it's obvious to me that from this theory the essential source for the origin of the idea "good" has been sought for and established in the wrong place: the judgment "good" does not originate from those to whom "goodness" was shown! On the contrary, it was the "good people" themselves, that is, the noble, powerful, higher-ranking, and higher-thinking people who felt and set themselves and their actions up as good, that is to say, of the first rank, in opposition to everything low, low-minded, common, and vulgar. From this pathos of distance they first arrogated to themselves the right to create values, to stamp out the names for values. What did they care about usefulness! Particularly in relation to such a hot pouring out of the highest rank-ordering, rank-setting judgments of value, the point of view which considers utility is as foreign and

inappropriate as possible. Here the feeling has reached the very opposite of the low level of warmth which is a condition for that calculating shrewdness, that reckoning by utility—and not just for a moment, not for one exceptional hour, but permanently. The pathos of nobility and distance, as I mentioned, the lasting and dominating feeling, something total and fundamental, of a higher ruling nature in relation to a lower type, to a “beneath”—that is the origin of the opposition between “good” and “bad.” (The right of the master to give names extends so far that we could permit ourselves to grasp the origin of language itself as an expression of the power of the rulers: they say “That is such and such”; they seal every object and event with a sound, and in the process, as it were, take possession of it.) Given this origin, the word “good” is from the start in no way necessarily tied up with “unegoistic” actions, as it is in the superstition of those genealogists of morality. Instead that occurs for the first time with the decline of aristocratic value judgments, when this entire contrast between “egoistic” and “unegoistic” presses itself ever more strongly into the human conscience—it is, to use my own words, the instinct of the herd which, through this contrast, finally gets its word (and its words). And even then, it takes a long time until this instinct in the masses becomes master, so that moral evaluation remains thoroughly hung up on and bogged down in that opposition (as is the case, for example, in modern Europe: today the prejudice that takes “moralistic,” “unegoistic,” and “*désintéressé* [disinterested]” as equally valuable ideas already governs with the force of a “fixed idea” and a disease of the brain). 3 Secondly, however, and quite apart from the fact that this hypothesis about the origin of the value judgment “good” is historically untenable, it suffers from an inherent psychological contradiction. The utility of the unegoistic action is supposed to be the origin of the praise it receives, and this origin has allegedly been forgotten:—but how is this forgetting even possible? Could the usefulness of such actions at some time or other perhaps just have stopped? The opposite is the case: this utility has rather been an everyday experience throughout the ages, and thus something that has always been constantly re-emphasized. Hence, instead of disappearing from consciousness, instead of becoming something forgettable, it must have pressed itself into the consciousness with ever-increasing clarity. How much more sensible is that contrasting theory (which is not therefore closer to the truth—) advocated, for example, by Herbert Spencer: he proposes that the idea “good” is essentially the same as the idea “useful” or “functional,” so that in judgments “good” and “bad” human beings sum up and endorse the experiences they have not forgotten and are unable to forget concerning the useful-functional and the harmful-useless.(1) According to this theory, good is something which has always proved useful, so that it may assert its validity as “valuable in the highest degree,” as “valuable in itself.” This path to an explanation is, as I said, also false, but at least the account itself is inherently sensible and psychologically

tenable. 4 I was given a hint of the right direction by the following question: What, from an etymological perspective, do the meanings of “good,” as manifested in different languages, really signify? There I found that all of them lead back to the same transformation of ideas—that everywhere “noble” and “aristocratic” in a social sense is the fundamental idea out of which “good” in the sense of “spiritually noble,” “aristocratic,” “spiritually high-minded,” “spiritually privileged” necessarily develops, a process which always runs in parallel with that other one that finally transforms “common,” “vulgar,” and “low” into the concept “bad.” The most eloquent example of the latter is the German word “(schlect [bad])” itself, which is identical with the word “schlicht [plain]” — compare “schlectweg [simply]” and “schlechterdings [simply]”—and which originally designated the plain, common man, still without any suspicious side glance, simply in contrast to the noble man. Around the time of the Thirty Years War approximately, hence late enough, this sense changed into the one used now.

(2) As far as the genealogy of morals is concerned, this point strikes me as a fundamental insight; that it was first discovered so late we can ascribe to the repressive influence which democratic prejudice in the modern world exercises concerning all questions of origin. And this occurs in what appears to be the most objective realm of natural science and physiology, a point I can only hint at here. But the sort of mischief this prejudice can cause, once it has become unleashed and turned into hatred, particularly where morality and history are concerned, is revealed in the well-known case of Buckle: the plebeian nature of the modern spirit, which originated in England, broke out once again on its home turf, as violently as a muddy volcano and with that salty, over-loud, and common eloquence with which all previous volcanoes have spoken up to now.

(3) 5 With respect to our problem—which for good reasons we can call a quiet problem and which addresses in a refined manner only a few ears—there is no little interest in establishing the point that often in those words and roots which designate “good” there still shines through the main nuance of what made the nobility feel they were men of higher rank. It’s true that in most cases they perhaps name themselves simply after their superiority in strength (as “the powerful,” “the masters,” “those in command”) or after the most visible sign of this superiority, for example, as “the rich” or “the owners” (that is the meaning of *arya* [noble], and the corresponding words in Iranian and Slavic). But they also name themselves after a typical characteristic, and this is the case which is our concern here. For instance, they call themselves “the truthful,” above all the Greek nobility, whose mouthpiece is the Megarian poet Theognis.

(4) The word developed for this characteristic, *ἔσθλος* [esthlos: fine, noble], indicates, according to its root meaning, a man who is, who possesses reality, who really exists, who is true. Then, with a subjective transformation, it indicates the true man as the truthful man. In this phase of conceptual transformation it becomes

the slogan and catch phrase for the nobility, and its sense shifts entirely over to mean “aristocratic,” to mark a distinction from the lying common man, as Theogonis takes and presents him—until finally, after the decline of the nobility, the word remains as a designation of spiritual noblesse [nobility] and becomes, as it were, ripe and sweet. In the word κακός [kakos: weak, worthless], as in the word δειλός [deilos: cowardly] (the plebeian in contrast to the ἀγαθός [agathos: good man]), the cowardice is emphasized. This perhaps provides a hint about the direction in which we have to seek the etymological origin for the multiple meanings of ἀγαθός [agathos: good]. In the Latin word malus [bad] (which I place alongside μέλας [melas: black, dark]) the common man could be designated as the dark-coloured, above all as the dark-haired (“hic niger est” [“this man is dark”]), as the pre-Aryan inhabitant of Italian soil, who through this colour stood out most clearly from those who became dominant, the blonds, that is, the conquering races of Aryans. At any rate, Gaelic offers me an exactly corresponding example—the word fin (for example, in the name Fin-Gal), the term designating nobility and finally the good, noble, and pure, originally referred to the blond-headed man in contrast to the dusky, dark-haired original inhabitants. Incidentally, the Celts were a thoroughly blond race. People are wrong when they link those traces of a basically dark-haired population, which are noticeable on the carefully prepared ethnographic maps of Germany, with any Celtic origin and mixing of blood, as Virchow still does.⁽⁵⁾ It is much rather the case that in these places the pre-Aryan population of Germany predominates. (The same is true for almost all of Europe: essentially the conquered races have finally attained the upper hand for themselves once again in colour, shortness of skull, perhaps even in the intellectual and social instincts. Who can confirm for us that modern democracy, the even more modern anarchism, and indeed that preference for the “Commune,” for the most primitive form of society, which all European socialists now share, does not indicate for the most part a monstrous throwback [Nachschlag]—and that the conquering master race, the race of Aryans, is not being physiologically defeated, too?). The Latin word bonus [good] I believe I can explicate as “the warrior,” provided that I am correct in tracing bonus back to an older word duonus (compare (T)bellum [war] = duellum [war] = duen-lum, which seems to me to contain that word duonus). Hence, bonus as a man of war, of division (duo [two]), as a warrior. We see what constituted a man’s “goodness” in ancient Rome. What about our German word “Gut” [good] itself? Doesn’t it indicate “den Göttlichen” [the god-like man], the man of “göttlichen Geschlechts” [“the family of gods”]? And isn’t that identical to the people’s (originally the nobles’) name for the Goths? The reasons for this hypothesis do not belong here.— 6 To this rule that the concept of political superiority always resolves itself into the concept of spiritual superiority, it is at first not an exception (although it may provide room for exceptions), when the

highest caste is also the priestly caste and consequently for its overall description prefers an attribute which recalls its priestly function. Here, for example, the words “pure” and “impure” first appear as contrasting marks of one’s social position, and here, too, a “good” and a “bad” also develop later with a meaning which no longer refers to social position. Incidentally, people should be warned not to begin by taking these ideas of “pure” and “impure” too seriously, too broadly, or even symbolically. Instead they should understand that all the ideas of ancient humanity, to a degree we can hardly imagine, are originally much more coarse, crude, superficial, narrow, blunt, and, in particular, unsymbolic. The “pure man” is initially simply a man who washes himself, who forbids himself certain foods that produce diseases of the skin, who doesn’t sleep with the dirty women of the lower people, who has a horror of blood—no more, not much more! On the other hand, of course, from the very nature of an essentially priestly aristocracy it is clear enough how precisely here the opposition between different evaluations could early on become dangerously internalized and sharpened. And, in fact, they finally ripped open fissures between man and man, over which even an Achilles of the free spirit could not cross without a shudder.

(6) From the beginning there has been something unhealthy about such priestly aristocracies and about the customary attitudes which govern in them, which turn away from action, sometimes brooding, sometimes exploding with emotion, as a result of which in the priests of almost all ages there have appeared almost unavoidably those debilitating intestinal illnesses and neurasthenia. But what they themselves came up with as a remedy for this pathological disease—surely we must assert that it has finally shown itself, through its effects, even a hundred times more dangerous than the illness for which it was to provide relief. Human beings themselves are still sick from the after-effects of this priestly naïveté in healing! Let’s think, for example, of certain forms of diet (avoiding meat), of fasting, of celibacy, of the flight “into the desert” (Weir-Mitchell’s isolation, but naturally without the fattening-up cure and overeating which follow it and which constitute the most effective treatment for all hysteria induced by the ascetic ideal): consider also the whole metaphysic of the priests, so hostile to the senses, making men lazy and sophisticated, the way they hypnotize themselves in the manner of fakirs and Brahmins—Brahmanism employed as a crystal ball and fixe Idee [fixed idea]—and finally the only too understandable and common dissatisfaction with its radical cure, with nothingness (or God—the desire for a unio mystica [mystical union] with God is the longing of the Buddhist for nothingness, nirvana—and nothing more!).(7) Among the priests, everything simply becomes more dangerous—not only the remedies and arts of healing, but also pride, vengeance, mental acuity, dissipation, love, thirst for power, virtue, and illness—although it’s fair enough also to add that on the foundation of this fundamentally dangerous form of human existence, the priestly, for the first time

the human being became, in general, an interesting animal, that here the human soul first attained depth in a higher sense and became evil—and, indeed, these are the two basic reasons for humanity's superiority, up to now, over other animals! You will have already guessed how easily the priestly way of evaluating can split from the knightly-aristocratic and then continue to develop into its opposite. Such a development receives a special stimulus every time the priestly caste and the warrior caste confront each other jealously and are not willing to agree amongst themselves about the reward. The knightly-aristocratic judgments of value have as their basic assumption a powerful physicality, a blooming, rich, even overflowing health, together with those things required to maintain these qualities—war, adventure, hunting, dancing, war games, and, in general, everything which involves strong, free, and happy action. The priestly-noble method of evaluating has, as we saw, other preconditions: these make it difficult enough for them when it comes to war! As is well known, priests are the most evil of enemies—but why? Because they are the most powerless. From their powerlessness, their hate grows among them into something huge and terrifying, to the most spiritual and most poisonous manifestations. The really great haters in world history and also the cleverest haters have always been priests—in comparison with the spirit of priestly revenge all the remaining spirits are hardly worth considering at all. Human history would be a really stupid affair without the spirit that entered it from the powerless. Let us quickly consider the greatest example. Nothing on earth which has been done against “the nobility,” “the powerful,” “the masters,” and “the possessors of power” is worth mentioning in comparison with what the Jews have done against them: the Jews, that priestly people, who knew how to get final satisfaction from their enemies and conquerors merely through a radical transformation of their values, that is, through an act of the most spiritual revenge. This was appropriate only to a priestly people with the most deeply suppressed priestly desire for revenge. In opposition to the aristocratic value equation (good = noble = powerful = beautiful = fortunate = loved by god), the Jews, with a consistency inspiring fear, dared to reverse things and to hang on to that with the teeth of the most profound hatred (the hate of powerlessness), that is, to “only those who suffer are good; the poor, the powerless, the low are the only good people; the suffering, those in need, the sick, the ugly are also the only pious people; only they are blessed by God; for them alone there is salvation.—By contrast, you privileged and powerful people, you are for all eternity the evil, the cruel, the lecherous, the insatiable, the godless; you will also be the unblessed, the cursed, and the damned for all eternity!” . . . We know who inherited this Judaic transformation of values . . . In connection with that huge and immeasurably disastrous initiative which the Jews launched with this most fundamental of all declarations of war, I recall the sentence I wrote at another time (in *Beyond Good and Evil*, page 118

(T)[Section 195])—namely, that with the Jews the slave rebellion in morality begins: that rebellion which has a two-thousand-year-old history behind it and which we nowadays no longer even notice because it—has triumphed.(8) 8 But you fail to understand that? You have no eye for something that needed two millennia to emerge victorious? . . . That’s nothing to wonder at: all lengthy things are hard to see, to assess. However, that is what took place: out of the trunk of that tree of vengeance and hatred, of Jewish hatred—the deepest and most sublime hatred, that is, a hatred which creates ideals and transforms values, something whose like has never existed on earth—from that grew something just as incomparable, a new love, the most profound and most sublime of all the forms of love:—from what other trunk could it have even grown? . . . However, one should not assume that this love arose essentially as the denial of that thirst for revenge, as the opposite of Jewish hatred! No. The reverse is the truth! This love grew out of that hatred, as its crown, as the victorious crown unfolding itself wider and wider in the purest brightness and radiant sunshine, the crown which, so to speak, was seeking in the kingdom of light and height the goal of that hate, aiming for victory, trophies, and seduction, with the same urgency with which the roots of that hatred were sinking down ever deeper and more greedily into everything profound and evil. This Jesus of Nazareth, the personified evangelist of love, this “Saviour” bringing holiness and victory to the poor, to the sick, to the sinners—was he not that very seduction in its most sinister and most irresistible form, the seduction and detour to exactly those Judaic values and innovations in ideals? Didn’t Israel attain, precisely with the detour of this “Saviour,” of this apparent enemy against and dissolver of Israel, the final goal of its sublime thirst for vengeance? Isn’t it part of the secret black art of a truly great politics of revenge, a farsighted, underground, slowly expropriating, and premeditated revenge, that Israel itself had to disown and nail to the cross, like some mortal enemy, the tool essential to its revenge before all the world, so that “all the world,” that is, all Israel’s enemies, could then take this particular bait without a second thought? On the other hand, could anyone, using the full subtlety of his mind, even imagine a more dangerous bait, something to match the enticing, intoxicating, narcotizing, corrupting power of that symbol of the “holy cross,” that ghastly paradox of a “god on the cross,” that mystery of an unimaginable and ultimate final cruelty and self-crucifixion of God for the salvation of mankind? . . . At least it is certain that sub hoc signo [under this sign] Israel, with its vengeance and revaluation of the worth of all other previous values, has triumphed again and again over all other ideals, over all nobler ideals. 9 —”But what are you doing still talking about nobler ideals! Let’s follow the facts: the people have triumphed—or ‘the slaves,’ or ‘the rabble,’ or ‘the herd,’ or whatever you want to call them—if this has taken place because of the Jews, then good for them! No people ever had a more world-historical mission. ‘The

masters' have been disposed of. The morality of the common man has prevailed. We may also take this victory as a blood poisoning (it did mix the races up together)—I don't deny that. But this intoxication has undoubtedly been successful. The 'salvation' of the human race (namely, from 'the masters') is well under way. Everything is visibly turning Jewish or Christian or plebeian (what do the words matter!). The progress of this poison through the entire body of humanity seems irresistible, although its tempo and pace may seem from now on constantly slower, more delicate, less audible, and more circumspect—well, we have time enough. . . . From this point of view, does the church today still have necessary work to do, does it still have a right to exist at all? Or could we dispense with it? Quaeritur [That's a question to be asked]. It seems that it rather obstructs and hinders the progress of that poison, instead of speeding it up? Well, that just might be what makes the church useful Certainly the church is for all intents and purposes something gross and vulgar, which a more delicate intelligence, a truly modern taste, resists. Shouldn't the church at least be something more sophisticated? Today it alienates more than it seduces. . . . Who among us would really be a free spirit if the church were not there? The church repels us, not its poison. . . . Apart from the church, we even love the poison. . . .”—This is the epilogue of a “freethinker” to my speech, an honest animal, as he has richly revealed, and in addition a democratic one. He listened to me up to that point and could not bear to hear my silence—since for me at this juncture there is much to be silent about. 10 The slave revolt in morality begins when the ressentiment itself becomes creative and gives birth to values: the ressentiment of those beings who are prevented from a genuine reaction, that is, something active, and who compensate for that with a merely imaginary vengeance.(9) Whereas all noble morality grows out of a triumphant affirmation of one's own self, slave morality from the start says “No” to what is “outside,” “other,” “not itself.” And this “No” is its creative act. This transformation of the glance which confers value—this necessary projection towards what is outer instead of back onto itself—that is inherent in ressentiment. In order to arise, slave morality always requires first an opposing world, a world outside itself. Psychologically speaking, it needs external stimuli in order to act at all—its action is basically reaction. The reverse is the case with the noble method of valuing: it acts and grows spontaneously. It seeks its opposite only to affirm its own self even more thankfully, with even more rejoicing—its negative concept of “low,” “common,” “bad” is merely a pale contrasting image after the fact in relation to its positive basic concept, thoroughly saturated with life and passion, “We are noble, good, beautiful, and happy!” When the noble way of evaluating makes a mistake and abuses reality, this happens with reference to the sphere which it does not know well enough, indeed, the sphere it has strongly resisted learning the truth about: under certain circumstances it misjudges the sphere it

despises, the sphere of the common man, of the low people. On the other hand, even if we assume that the feeling of contempt, of looking down, or of looking superior falsifies the image of the person despised, we should note that such distortion will fall short by a long way of the distortion with which the suppressed hatred and vengeance of the powerless man assaults his opponent—naturally, in effigy. In fact, contempt contains too much negligence, too much lack of concern, too much looking away and impatience mixed in with it, even too much of a personal feeling of joy, for it to be capable of converting its object into a truly distorted image and monster. We should not fail to hear the almost benevolent nuances which, for example, the Greek nobility places in all the words with which it separates itself from the lower people—how a constant form of pity, consideration, and forbearance is mixed in there, sweetening the words, to the point where almost all words referring to the common man finally remain as expressions for “unhappy” and “worthy of pity” (compare δειλός [deilos: cowardly], δειλῆσιος [delaios: mean, low], πονηρός [poneros: oppressed by toil, wretched], μοχθηρός [mochtheros: suffering, wretched]—the last two basically designating the common man as a slave worker and beast of burden)—and how, on the other hand, for the Greek ear the words “bad,” “low,” and “unhappy” have never stopped echoing a single note, one tone colour, in which “unhappy” predominates. This is the inheritance of the old, nobler, and aristocratic way of evaluating, which does not betray its principles even in contempt. (—Philologists should recall the sense in which οἰζυρός [oizuros: miserable], ἀνόλβος [anolbos: unblest], τλήμων [tlemon: wretched] δυστυχεῖν [dystychein: unfortunate] and ξυμφορά [xymfora: misfortune] were used). The “well born” simply felt they were “the happy ones”; they did not have to construct their happiness artificially first by looking at their enemies, or in some circumstances to talk themselves into it, to lie to themselves into it (the way all men of resentment habitually do). Similarly they knew, as complete men overloaded with power and thus necessarily active, that they must not separate action from happiness—they considered being active necessarily associated with happiness (that’s where the phrase εὖ πράττειν [eu prattein: do well, succeed] derives its origin)—all this is very much the opposite of “happiness” at the level of the powerless and oppressed, those festering with poisonous and hostile feelings, among whom happiness comes out essentially as a narcotic, an anaesthetic, quiet, peace, “Sabbath,” relaxing the soul, and stretching one’s limbs, in short, as something passive. While the noble man lives for himself with trust and candour (γενναῖος [gennaios], meaning “of noble birth,” stresses the nuance “upright” and also probably “naive”), the man of resentment is neither upright nor naive, nor honest and direct with himself. His soul squints. His spirit loves hiding places, secret paths, and back doors. Everything furtive attracts him as his world, his security, his refreshment. He understands about remaining silent, not forgetting,

waiting, temporarily diminishing himself, humiliating himself. A race of such men of resentment will inevitably end up cleverer than any noble race. It will also value cleverness to a completely different extent, that is, as a condition of existence of the utmost importance; whereas, cleverness among noble men easily acquires a delicate aftertaste of luxury and sophistication about it:—here it is simply far less important than the complete functional certainty of the ruling unconscious instincts or even a certain lack of cleverness, something like brave recklessness, whether in the face of danger or of an enemy, or those wildly enthusiastic, sudden fits of anger, love, reverence, thankfulness, and vengeance, by which in all ages noble souls have recognized each other. The resentment of the noble man himself, if it comes over him, consumes and exhausts itself in an immediate reaction and therefore does not poison. On the other hand, in countless cases it just does not appear at all; whereas, in the case of all weak and powerless people it is unavoidable. Being unable to take one's enemies, one's misfortunes, even one's bad deeds seriously for any length of time—that is the mark of strong, complete natures, in whom there is a surplus of plastic, creative, healing power, as well as the power to make one forget (a good example for that from the modern world is Mirabeau, who had no memory of the insults and the maliciousness people directed at him and who therefore could not forgive, merely because he—forgot). Such a man with a single shrug simply throws off himself the many worms which eat into other men.⁽¹⁰⁾ Only here is the real “love for one's enemy” even possible—provided that it is at all possible on earth.—How much respect a noble man already has for his enemies!—and such a respect is already a bridge to love. . . . In fact, he demands his enemy for himself, as his mark of honour. Indeed, he has no enemy other than one in whom there is nothing to despise and a great deal to respect! By contrast, imagine for yourself “the enemy” as a man of resentment conceives him—and right here we have his action, his creation: he has conceptualized “the evil enemy,” “the evil one,” as, in fact, a fundamental idea from which he now also thinks his way to a complementary image and counterpart, a “good man”—himself! . . . ¹¹ We see exactly the opposite with the noble man, who conceives the fundamental idea “good” in advance and spontaneously, that is, from himself, and from there he first creates a picture of “bad” for himself! This “bad” originating from the noble man and that “evil” arising out of the stew pot of insatiable hatred—of these the first is a later creation, an afterthought, a complementary colour; by contrast, the second is the original, the beginning, the essential act in the conception of a slave morality—although the two words “bad” and “evil” both seem opposite to the same idea of “good,” how different they are! But it is not the same idea of “good.” Instead we should ask who the “evil person” really is in the sense of the morality of resentment. The strict answer to that is as follows: simply the “good person” of the other morality, the noble man, the powerful, the ruling man, only

coloured over, only re-interpreted, only looked at again through the poisonous eyes of resentment. Here there is one thing we will be the last to deny: whoever has come to know those “good men” only as enemies, has known them also as nothing but evil enemies, and the same people who are kept within such strict limits by custom, honour, habit, gratitude, and even more by mutual surveillance and jealousy *inter pares* [among equals] and who, by contrast, demonstrate in relation to each other such resourceful consideration, self-control, refinement, loyalty, pride, and friendship—to the outside, where the strange world, the world of what is foreign to them, begins, these men are not much better than beasts of prey turned loose. Here they enjoy freedom from all social constraints. In the wilderness they make up for the tension which a long fenced-in confinement within the peace of the community brings about. They go back to the innocent conscience of a beast of prey, as joyful monsters, who perhaps walk away from a dreadful sequence of murder, arson, rape, and torture with an exhilaration and spiritual equilibrium, as if they had merely pulled off a student prank, convinced that now the poets once again have something to sing about and praise for a long time to come. At the bottom of all these noble races we cannot fail to recognize the beast of prey, the blond beast splendidly roaming around in its lust for loot and victory. This hidden basis from time to time needs to be discharged: the beast must come out again, must go back into the wilderness once more,—Roman, Arab, German, Japanese nobility, Homeric heroes, Scandinavian Vikings—in this need they are all alike. It is the noble races that left behind the concept of the “barbarian” in all their tracks, wherever they went. A consciousness of and even a pride in this fact still reveals itself in their highest culture (for example, when Pericles says to his Athenians, in that famous funeral speech, “our audacity has broken a way through to every land and sea, putting up permanent memorials to itself for good and ill”). This “audacity” of the noble races, mad, absurd, and sudden in the way it expresses itself, its unpredictability, even the improbability of its undertakings—Pericles emphatically praises the *ῥαθυμία* [rathumia: freedom of anxiety] of the Athenians—their indifference to and contempt for safety, body, life, comfort, their fearsome cheerfulness and the depth of their joy in all destruction, in all the physical pleasures of victory and cruelty—all this was summed up for those who suffered from such audacity in the image of the “barbarian,” of the “evil enemy,” of something like the “Goth” or “Vandal.”(11) The deep, icy mistrust which the German evokes, as soon as he comes to power, once more again today—is still an after-effect of that unforgettable terror with which for centuries Europe confronted the rage of the blond Germanic beast (although there is hardly any idea linking the old Germanic tribes and we Germans, let alone any blood relationship). Once before I have remarked on Hesiod’s dilemma when he thought up his sequence of cultural periods and sought to express them as Gold, Silver, and Iron.(12) He didn’t know what to do

with the contradiction presented to him by the marvellous but, at the same time, so horrifying and violent world of Homer, other than to make two cultural ages out of one and then place one after the other—first the Age of Heroes and Demigods from Troy and Thebes, just as that world remained in the memories of the noble families who had their own ancestors in it, and then the Age of Iron as that same world appeared to the descendants of the downtrodden, exploited, ill treated, and those carried off and sold—an age of iron, as mentioned: hard, cold, cruel, empty of feeling and scruples, with everything crushed and covered with blood.(13) Assuming as true what in any event is taken as “the truth” nowadays, that it is the point of all culture simply to breed a tame and civilized animal, a domestic pet, out of the beast of prey “man,” then we would undoubtedly have to consider all those instincts of reaction and of resentment with whose help the noble races and all their ideals were finally disgraced and overpowered as the essential instruments of culture—though to do that would not yet be to claim that the bearers of these instincts also in themselves represented culture. Instead, the opposite would not only be probable—no! nowadays it is visibly apparent! These people carrying instincts of oppression and of a lust for revenge, the descendants of all European and non-European slavery, of all pre-Aryan populations in particular—they represent the regression of mankind! These “instruments of culture” are a disgrace to humanity and more a reason to be suspicious of or a counterargument against “culture” in general! We may well be right when we hang onto our fear of the blond beast at the bottom of all noble races and keep up our guard. But who would not find it a hundred times better to fear, if he could at the same time admire, rather than not fear but in the process no longer be able to rid himself of the disgusting sight of the failures, the stunted, the emaciated, and the poisoned? And is not that our fate? Today what is it that constitutes our aversion to “man”?—For we suffer from man. There’s no doubt of that. It is not a matter of fear. Rather it’s the fact that we have nothing more to fear from man, that the maggot “man” is in the foreground swarming around, that the “tame man,” the hopelessly mediocre and unedifying man, has already learned to feel that he is the goal, the pinnacle, the meaning of history, “the higher man,”—yes indeed, that he has a certain right to feel that about himself, insofar as he feels separate from the excessive number of failed, sick, tired, and spent people, who are nowadays beginning to make Europe stink, so that he senses that he is at least relatively successful, at least still capable of life, of at least saying “Yes” to life.

12 —At this point I won’t suppress a sigh and a final confidence. What is it exactly that I find so totally unbearable? Something which I cannot deal with on my own, which makes me choke and feel faint? Bad air! Bad air! That something which has failed is coming close to me, that I have to smell the entrails of a failed soul! . . . Apart from that what can we not endure by way of need, deprivation, bad weather, infirmity, hardship, and loneliness? Basically we can

deal with all the other things, born as we are to an underground and struggling existence. We come back again and again into the light, we live over and over our golden hour of victory—and then we stand there, just as we were born, unbreakable, tense, ready for something new, for something even more difficult, more distant, like a bow which all troubles only serve to pull even tighter. But if there are heavenly goddesses who are our patrons, beyond good and evil, then from time to time grant me a glimpse, just grant me a single glimpse at something perfect, something completely developed, happy, powerful, triumphant, from which there is still something to fear! A glimpse of a man who justifies the human being, of a complementary and redeeming stroke-of-luck [Glücksfall] of a man, for whose sake we can hang onto a faith in humanity! . . . For matters stand like this: the diminution and levelling of European man conceal our greatest danger, since we grow tired at the sight of him . . . We see nothing today which wants to be greater. We suspect that things are still going down, down into something thinner, more good-natured, more prudent, more comfortable, more mediocre, more indifferent, more Chinese, more Christian—humanity, there is no doubt, is becoming constantly “better.” . . . Europe’s fate lies right here—with the fear of man we also have lost the love for him, the reverence for him, the hope for him, indeed, our will to him. A glimpse at man nowadays makes us tired—what is contemporary nihilism, if it is not that? . . . We are weary of man. . . . 13 —But let’s come back: the problem with the other origin of the “good,” of the good man, as the person of resentment has imagined it for himself, demands its own conclusion.—That the lambs are upset about the great predatory birds is not strange, but the fact that these large birds of prey snatch away small lambs provides no reason for holding anything against them. And if the lambs say among themselves, “These predatory birds are evil, and whoever is least like a predatory bird and instead is like its opposite, a lamb—shouldn’t that animal be good?” there is nothing to find fault with in this setting up of an ideal, except for the fact that the birds of prey will look down on them with a little mockery and perhaps say to themselves, “We are not at all annoyed with these good lambs. We even love them. Nothing is tastier than a tender lamb.” To demand from strength that it does not express itself as strength, that it does not consist of a will to overpower, a will to throw down, a will to rule, a thirst for enemies and opposition and triumphs, is just as unreasonable as to demand from weakness that it express itself as strength. A quantum of force is simply such a quantum of drive, will, and action—rather, it is nothing but this very driving, willing, and acting itself—and it cannot appear as anything else except through the seduction of language (and the fundamental errors of reason petrified in it), which understands and misunderstands all action as conditioned by something which causes actions, by a “subject.” For, in just the same way as people separate lightning from its flash and take the latter as an action, as the

effect of a subject called lightning, so popular morality separates strength from manifestations of strength, as if behind the strong person there were an indifferent substrate that is free to express strength or not. But there is no such substrate; there is no “being” behind the doing, acting, or becoming. “The doer” is merely fabricated and added into the action—the act is everything. People basically duplicate the action: when they see a lightning flash, that is an action-action [ein Thun-Thun]: they set up the same event first as the cause and then yet again as its effect. Natural scientists are no better when they say “Force moves, force causes,” and so on—our entire scientific knowledge, for all its coolness and freedom from feelings, still remains exposed to the seduction of language and has not gotten rid of the changelings foisted on it, the “subjects” (the atom, for example, is such a changeling, like the Kantian “thing-in-itself”): it’s no wonder, then, that the repressed, secretly smouldering feelings of revenge and hate use this belief for their own purposes and even, in fact, maintain a faith in nothing more fervently than in the idea that the strong person is free to be weak and that the predatory bird is free to be a lamb:—in so doing, of course, they arrogate to themselves the right to blame the bird of prey for being a bird of prey. . . . When the oppressed, the downtrodden, and the violated say to each other, with the vengeful cunning of the powerless, “Let us be different from evil people, namely, good! And every person is good who does not oppress, who hurts no one, who does not attack, who does not retaliate, who hands revenge over to God, who keeps himself hidden, as we do, the person who avoids all evil and demands little from life in general, like us, the patient, humble, and upright”—what that amounts to, coolly expressed and without bias, is essentially nothing more than “We weak people are merely weak. It’s good if we do not do anything for which we are not strong enough”—but this bitter state, this shrewdness of the lowest ranks, which even insects possess (when in great danger they act as if they were dead in order not to do “too much”), has, thanks to that counterfeiting and self-deception of powerlessness, dressed itself in the splendour of a self-denying, still, patient virtue, as if the weakness of the weak man himself—that means his essence, his actions, his entire single, inevitable, and irredeemable reality—is a voluntary achievement, something willed, chosen, an action, something of merit. This kind of man has to believe in the disinterested, freely choosing “subject” out of an instinct for self-preservation and self-affirmation, in which every falsehood is habitually sanctified. Hence, the subject (or, to use a more popular style, the soul) has up to now perhaps been the best principle for belief on earth, because for the majority of the dying, the weak, and the downtrodden of all sorts it makes possible that sublime self-deception that establishes weakness itself as freedom and their being like this or that as a commendable act. 14 Is there anyone who would like to take a little look down on and under that secret how man fabricates ideals on earth? Who has the courage for that? . . . Come on, now! Here’s an

open glimpse into this dark workshop. Just wait a moment, my dear Mr. Curious Daredevil: your eye must first get used to this artificial flickering light. . . . So, enough! Now speak! What's going on down there? Speak up. Say what you see, man of the most dangerous curiosity—now I'm the one who's listening.—“I see nothing, but I hear all the more. It is a careful, crafty, light rumour-mongering and whispering from every nook and cranny. It seems to me that people are lying; a sugary mildness clings to every sound. Weakness is going to be falsified into something of merit. There's no doubt about it—things are just as you said.” —Keep talking! —“And powerlessness that does not retaliate is being falsified into ‘goodness,’ anxious baseness into ‘humility,’ submission before those one hates to ‘obedience’ (of course, obedience to the one who, they say, commands this submission—they call him God). The inoffensiveness of the weak man—cowardice itself, in which he is rich, his standing at the door, his inevitable need to wait around—here acquires good names, like ‘patience,’ and is even called the virtue. That incapacity for revenge is called the lack of desire for revenge, perhaps even forgiveness (‘for they know not what they do—only we know what they do!’). People are even talking about ‘love for one's enemies’—and sweating as they say it.” —Keep talking! —“They are miserable—there's no doubt about that—all these rumour-mongers and counterfeiterers in the corners, although crouched down beside each other in the warmth—but they are telling me that their misery is God's choice, His sign, that one beats the dog one loves the most, that this misery may perhaps be a preparation, a test, an education, perhaps it is even more—something that will one day be requited and paid out with huge interest in gold, no, in happiness. They call that ‘blessedness’.” —Go on! —“Now they are letting me know that they are not only better than the powerful, the masters of the earth, whose spit they have to lick (not out of fear, certainly not out of fear, but because God commands that they honour all those in authority)—that they are not only better than these, but also ‘better off,’ or at any rate will one day have it better. But enough! Enough! I can't take it anymore. Bad air! Bad air! This workshop where man fabricates ideals—it seems to me it stinks of nothing but lies.” —No! Just one minute more! So far you haven't said anything about the masterpiece of these black magicians who make whiteness, milk, and innocence out of every blackness:—have you not noticed the perfection of their raffinement [sophistication], their most daring, most refined, most imaginative, and most fallacious artistic attempt? Pay attention! These cellar animals full of vengeance and hatred—what exactly are they making out of that vengeance and hatred? Have you ever heard these words? If you heard only their words, would you suspect that you were completely among men of resentment? . . . —“I understand. Once again I'll open my ears (oh! oh! oh! and hold my nose). Now I'm hearing for the first time what they've been saying so often: ‘We good men—we are the righteous’—what they demand they don't call

repayment but 'the triumph of righteousness.' What they hate is not their enemy. No! They hate 'injustice,' 'godlessness.' What they believe and hope for is not a hope for revenge, the intoxication of sweet vengeance (something Homer has already called 'sweeter than honey'), but the victory of God, the righteous God, over the godless. What remains for them to love on earth is not their brothers in hatred but their 'brothers in love,' as they say, all the good and righteous people on the earth." —And what do they call what serves them as a consolation for all the suffering of life—the phantasmagoria of future blessedness which they are waiting for? —"What's that? Am I hearing correctly? They call that 'the last judgment,' the coming of their kingdom, the coming of 'God's kingdom'—but in the meanwhile they live 'in faith,' 'in love,' 'in hope.'" —Enough! Enough! 15 In belief in what? In love with what? In hope for what?—There's no doubt that these weak people—at some time or another they also want to be the strong people, some day their "kingdom" is to arrive—they call it simply "the kingdom of God," as I mentioned. People are indeed so humble about everything! Only to experience that, one has to live a long time, beyond death—in fact, people must have an eternal life, so they can also win eternal recompense in the "kingdom of God" for that earthly life "in faith, in love, in hope." Recompense for what? Recompense through what? . . . In my view, Dante was grossly in error when, with an ingenuousness inspiring terror, he set that inscription over the gateway into his hell: "Eternal love also created me." (14) Over the gateway into the Christian paradise and its "eternal blessedness" it would, in any event, be more fitting to let the inscription stand "Eternal hate also created me"—provided it's all right to set a truth over the gateway to a lie! For what is the bliss of that paradise? . . . Perhaps we might have guessed that already, but it is better for it to be expressly described for us by an authority we cannot underestimate in such matters, Thomas Aquinas, the great teacher and saint: "In the kingdom of heaven" he says as gently as a lamb, "the blessed will see the punishment of the damned, so that they will derive all the more pleasure from their heavenly bliss." (15) Or do you want to hear that message in a stronger tone, for example, from the mouth of a triumphant father of the church, who warns his Christians against the cruel sensuality of the public spectacles. (16) But why? "Faith, in fact, offers much more to us," he says (in *de Spectaculis* [On Spectacles] c. 29 ff), "something much stronger. Thanks to the redemption, very different joys are ours to command; in place of the athletes, we have our martyrs. If we want blood, well, we have the blood of Christ . . . But what awaits us on the day of His coming again, of His triumph!"—and now he takes off, the rapturous visionary: "However, there are other spectacles—that last eternal day of judgment, ignored and derided by nations, when after so many years the old age of the world and all the many things they produced will be burned in a single fire. What a broad spectacle then appears! How I will be lost in admiration! How I will laugh! How

I will rejoice! How I will exult, as I see so many great kings who by public report were accepted into heaven groaning in the deepest darkness alongside those very men who testified on their behalf, along with Jove himself! They will include governors of provinces who persecuted the name of our Lord melting in flames fiercer than those with which they proudly raged against the Christians! And then those wise philosophers who convinced their disciples that nothing was of any concern to God and who claimed either that there is no such thing as a soul or that our souls would not return to their original bodies are shamed before those very disciples as they burn in the conflagration with them! And the poets, too, shaking with fear, not in front of the tribunal of Rhadamanthus or Minos, but of the Christ they did not anticipate!(17) Then it will be easier to hear the tragic actors, because their voices will be more resonant in their own calamity” (better voices since they will be screaming in even greater terror). “The comic actors will then be easy to recognize, for the fire will make them much more agile. Then the charioteer will be on show, all red in a wheel of fire, and the athletes will be visible, thrown, not in the gymnasium, but into the flames, unless I have no wish to look at them then, so that I can more readily cast an insatiable gaze on those who raged against our Lord.(18)‘This is the man,’ I will say, ‘the son of a workman or a prostitute’” (in everything that follows and especially in the well-known description of the mother of Jesus from the Talamud, Tertullian from this point on is referring to the Jews) “the destroyer of the Sabbath, the Samaritan possessed by the devil. He is the man whom you bought from Judas, the man who was beaten with a reed and with fists, reviled with spit, who was given gall and vinegar to drink. He is the man whom his disciples took away in secret, so that it could be said that he was resurrected, or whom the gardener took away, so that the crowd of visitors would not harm his lettuce.’ What praetor or consul or quaestor or priest will from his own generosity grant you this so that you may see such sights, so that you can exult in such things?(19) And yet we already have these things to a certain extent through faith, represented to us by the imagining spirit. Besides, what sorts of things has the eye not seen or the ear not heard and what sorts of things have not arisen in the human heart? (1. Cor. 2, 9). I believe these are more pleasing than the race track and the circus and both enclosures” (the first and fourth tier of seats or, according to others, the comic and tragic stages).(20) Through faith: that’s how it’s written. 16 Let’s bring this to a conclusion. The two opposing values “good and bad” and “good and evil” have fought a fearful battle on earth for thousands of years. And if it’s true that the second value has for a long time had the upper hand, even now there is still no lack of places where the battle goes on without a final decision. We could even say that in the intervening time the battle has been constantly drawn to greater heights and, in the process, to constantly greater depths and has become constantly more spiritual, so that nowadays there is perhaps no more decisive

mark of a “higher nature,” a more spiritual nature, than that it is split in that sense and is truly still a battleground for those opposites. The symbol of this battle, written in a script which has remained legible through all human history up to the present, is called “Rome against Judea, Judea against Rome.” To this point there has been no greater event than this war, this posing of a question, this contradiction between deadly enemies. Rome felt that the Jew was like something contrary to nature itself, its monstrous polar opposite, as it were. In Rome the Jew was considered “convicted of hatred against the entire human race.” And that view was correct, to the extent that we are right to link the health and the future of the human race to the unconditional rule of aristocratic values, to Roman values. By contrast, how did the Jews feel about Rome? We can guess that from a thousand signs, but it is sufficient to treat ourselves again to the Apocalypse of John, that wildest of all written outbursts which vengeance has on its conscience. (Incidentally, we must not underestimate the deep consistency of the Christian instinct when it ascribed this particular book of hate to the name of the disciple of love, the same man to whom it attributed that enthusiastic amorous gospel—: there is some truth to this, no matter how much literary counterfeiting may have been necessary for this purpose). The Romans were indeed strong and noble men, stronger and nobler than any people who had lived on earth up until then or even than any people who had ever been dreamed up. Everything they left as remains, every inscription, is delightful, provided that we can guess what is doing the writing there. By contrast, the Jews were par excellence that priestly people of resentment, who possessed an unparalleled genius for popular morality. Just compare people with related talents—say, the Chinese or the Germans—with the Jews, in order to understand which is ranked first and which is ranked fifth. Which of them has proved victorious for the time being, Rome or Judea? Surely there’s not the slightest doubt. Just think of who it is people bow down to today in Rome itself as the personification of all the highest values—and not only in Rome, but in almost half the earth, all the places where people have become merely tame or want to become tame—in front of three Jews, as we know, and one Jewess (in front of Jesus of Nazareth, the fisherman Peter, the carpet maker Paul, and the mother of the first-mentioned Jesus, named Mary). This is very remarkable: without doubt Rome has been conquered. It is true that in the Renaissance there was an incredibly brilliant reawakening of the classical ideal, of the noble way of evaluating everything. Rome itself behaved like someone who had woken up from a coma induced by the pressure of the new Jewish Rome built over it, which looked like an ecumenical synagogue and was called “Church.” But Judea immediately triumphed again, thanks to that thoroughly vulgar (German and English) movement of resentment we call the Reformation, together with what had to follow as a result, the re-establishment of the church—as well as the re-

establishment of the old grave-like tranquillity of classical Rome. In what is an even more decisive and deeper sense than that, Judea once again was victorious over the classical ideal with the French Revolution. The last political nobility which there was in Europe, in seventeenth and eighteenth century France, broke apart under the instincts of popular ressentiment—never on earth has there been heard a greater rejoicing, a noisier enthusiasm! It's true that in the midst of all this the most dreadful and most unexpected events took place: the old ideal itself stepped physically and with unheard of splendour before the eyes and the conscience of humanity—and once again stronger, simpler, and more urgently than ever rang out, in opposition to the old lying slogan of ressentiment about the privileged rights of the majority, in opposition to that will for a low condition, for abasement, for equality, for the decline and twilight of mankind—in opposition to all that there rang out the fearsome and delightful counter-slogan about the privilege of the very few! As a last signpost to a different road, Napoleon appeared, that most singular and late-born man there ever was, and in him the problem of the noble ideal itself was made flesh—we should consider well what a problem that is: Napoleon, this synthesis of monster [Unmensch] and superman [Übermensch] . . . 17 —Did that end it? Was that greatest of all oppositions of ideals thus set ad acta [aside] for all time? Or was it merely postponed, postponed indefinitely? . . . Someday would there not have to be an even more fearful blaze from the old fire, one which would take much longer to prepare? More than that: would this not be exactly what we should hope for with all our strength? Even will it? Even demand it? Anyone who, like my readers, begins to reflect on these points, to think further, will have difficulty coming to a quick conclusion—reason enough for me to come to a conclusion myself, provided that it has been sufficiently clear for a long time what I want, precisely what I want with that dangerous slogan which is written on the body of my last book: “Beyond Good and Evil” . . . At least this does not mean “Beyond Good and Bad.”— Note I am taking the opportunity provided to me by this essay publicly and formally to state a desire which I have expressed up to now only in occasional conversations with scholars, namely, that some faculty of philosophy might set up a series of award-winning academic essays in order to serve the advancement of studies into the history of morality. Perhaps this book could serve to provide a forceful push in precisely such a direction. Bearing in mind a possibility of this sort, let me propose the following question—it merits the attention of philologists and historians as much as of truly professional philosophical scholars: What suggestions does the scientific study of language, especially etymological research, provide for the history of the development of moral concepts? —On the other hand, it is, of course, just as necessary to attract the participation of physiologists and doctors to these problems (of the value of all methods of evaluating up to now). Also for this task it might be left to the

professional philosophers in this particular case to become advocates and mediators, after they have completely succeeded in converting the relationships between philosophy, physiology, and medicine, originally so aloof and so mistrusting, into the most friendly and most fruitful exchange. In fact, all the tables of value, all examples of “thou shalt” that history or ethnological research knows about, need, first and foremost, illumination and interpretation from physiology—at any rate before one from psychology. All of them similarly await a critique from the point of view of medical science. The question “What is this or that table of values and ‘morality’ worth?” needs to be viewed from the most varied perspectives. For we cannot analyze the question “Value for what?” too finely. Something, for example, that would have an apparent value with respect to the longest possible capacity for the survival of a race (or to an increase in its power to adapt to a certain climate or to the preservation of the greatest number) would have nothing like the same value, if the issue were one of developing a stronger type. The well-being of the greatest number and the well-being of the smallest number are opposing viewpoints where values are concerned. We wish to leave it to the naïveté of English biologists to take the first as already the one of inherently higher value. . . . All the sciences from now on have to do the preparatory work for the future job of the philosopher, understanding that the philosopher’s task is to solve the problem of value, that he has to determine the rank order of values. ENDNOTES (1) Herbert Spencer (1820-1903), English philosopher and liberal political theorist, who extended Darwin’s evolutionary theories into sociology. [Back to Text] (2) Thirty Years War: a prolonged, devastating, and inconclusive European war over religion (1618-1648). [Back to Text] (3) Buckle: Henry Thomas Buckle (1821-1862), English historian, author of *The History of Civilization in England*. Buckle’s attempt to explain historical events as the results of certain mathematically precise laws generated a great deal of controversy. [Back to Text] (4) Theogonis: a Greek poet from Megara in the sixth century BC. [Back to Text] (5) Virchow: Rudolf Virchow (1821-1902), German doctor and anthropologist. [Back to Text] (6) Achilles: the warrior hero of Homer’s *Iliad*, one of the greatest Greek heroes. [Back to Text] (7) Weir-Mitchell: Silas Weir-Mitchell (1829-1914), American doctor and writer, well known for his rest cure for nervous diseases. [Back to Text] (8) *Beyond Good and Evil*: Nietzsche published this work in 1886. [Back to Text] (9) . . . ressentiment: Nietzsche uses this French word, which since his writing, and largely because of it, has entered the English language as an important term in psychology: a short definition is as follows: “deep-seated resentment, frustration, and hostility, accompanied by a sense of being powerless to express these feelings directly” (Merriam-Webster). Ressentiment is thus significantly different in meaning from resentment. [Back to Text] (10) Mirabeau: Honore Gabriel Riqueti, Comte de Mirabeau (1749-1791), French politician and writer at the

time of the French Revolution. [Back to Text] (11) Pericles (495-429 BC), political leader and general in Athens at the outbreak of the Peloponnesian War. He delivered his famous funeral oration at the end of the first year of the war. The Goths: tribes from Eastern Germany who attacked the Roman Empire in the third and fourth centuries. Later (as the Visigoths and Ostrogoths) they gained political dominance in parts of Europe, once the Roman Empire collapsed; Vandals: Eastern Germanic tribes, allied to the Goths, who invaded the Roman Empire. [Back to Text] (12) Hesiod (c. 700 BC), Greek poet. [Back to Text] (13) Nietzsche's point here is that Hesiod broke the last of his ages into two: a Heroic Age, symbolized by the legendary heroes of Troy and Thebes, and an Iron Age. The latter was, in effect, the same as the Heroic Age except it was that era as seen by the suffering and oppressed (i.e., not a heroic and glorious period, but one full of wretchedness). Hesiod (in *Works and Days*) describes five ages: Gold, Silver, Bronze, Heroic, and Iron. Nietzsche's German word *Erz* can mean ore, bronze, or iron. [Back to Text] (14) Dante: Dante Alighieri (1265-1321), a Florentine poet who wrote *The Divine Comedy*. The phrase Nietzsche quotes comes from the first book, *The Inferno*, and stands over the gateway to hell. [Back to Text] (15) Thomas Aquinas (1225-1274), Catholic saint, one of the great Catholic theologians. Nietzsche quotes the Latin, as follows: "Beati in regno coelesti videbunt poenas damnatorum, ut beatitudo illis magis complacet." [Back to Text] (16) The "triumphant father of the church" is Tertullian (c. 155-230), an important figure in the early church and a fierce Christian apologist. [Back to Text] (17) Rhadamanthus or Minos: These were the names of the judges in the pagan underworld. [Back to Text] (18) Nietzsche's Latin quotation of Tertullian contains in this sentence a slight misquote: "vivos" [living] rather than visos [seen]. The English text above uses visos (Tertullian's word). [Back to Text] (19) praetor or consul or quaestor: important Roman political officials. [Back to Text] (20) Nietzsche quotes the Latin and inserts some of his own comments, as follows: "At enim supersunt alia spectacula, ille ultimus et perpetuus iudicii dies, ille nationibus insperatus, ille derisus, cum tanta saeculi vetustas et tot eius natiuitates uno igne hauriuntur. Quae tunc spectaculi latitudo! Quid admirer! Quid rideam! Ubi gaudeam! Ubi exultem, spectans tot et tantos reges, qui in coelum recepti nuntiabantur, cum ipso Iove et ipsis suis testibus in imis tenebris congemescerent! Item praesides" (die Provinzialstatthalter) "persecutores dominici nominis saevioribus quam ipsi flammis saevierunt insultantibus contra Christianos liquescentes! Quos praeterea sapientes illos philosophos coram discipulis suis una conflagrantibus erubescerent, quibus nihil ad deum pertinere suadebant, quibus animas aut nullas aut non in pristina corpora redituras affirmabant! Etiam poetas non ad Rhadamanti nec ad Minois, sed ad inopinati Christi tribunal palpitantes! Tunc magis tragoedi audiendi, magis scilicet vocales" (besser bei Stimme, noch ärgere

Schreier) “in sua propria calamitate; tunc histriones cognoscendi, solutiores multo per ignem; tunc spectandus auriga in flammea rota totus rubens, tunc xysticcontemplandi non in gymnasiis, sed in igne jaculati, nisi quod ne tunc quidem illos velim vivos, ut qui malim ad eos potius conspectum insatiabilem conferre, qui in dominum desaevierunt. Hic est ille,’ dicam, ‘fabri aut quaestuariae filius’” (wie alles Folgende und insbesondere auch diese aus dem Talmud bekannte Bezeichnung der Mutter Jesu zeigt, meint Tertullian von hier ab die Juden), “‘sabbati destructor, Samarites et daemonium habens. Hic est, quem a Juda redemistis, hic est ille arundine et colaphis diverberatus, sputamentis dedecoratus, felle et aceto potatus. Hic est, quem clam discentes subripuerunt, ut resurrexisse dicatur vel hortulanus detraxit, ne lactucae suae frequentia commeantium laederentur.’ Ut talia spectes, uttalibus exultes, quis tibi praetor aut consul aut quaestor aut sacerdos de sua liberalitate praestabit? Et tamen haec jam habemus quodammodo per fidem spiritu imaginante repraesentata. Ceterum qualia illa sunt, quae nec oculus vidit nec auris audivit nec in cor hominis ascenderunt?” (1. Cor. 2, 9.) “Credo circo et utraque cavea” (erster und vierter Rang oder, nach anderen, komische und tragische Bühne) “et omni stadio gratiora.” [Back to Text] [Link to Genealogy of Morals, Table of Contents] Link to Second Essay Nietzsche, Genealogy, Essay 2 Friedrich Nietzsche On the Genealogy of Morals A Polemical Tract Translated by Ian Johnston Vancouver Island University Nanaimo, British Columbia 2014 [Students, teachers, artists, and members of the general public may download and distribute this text free of charge and without permission. They may also freely edit the text to suit their purposes. However, no commercial publication of this text or any part of it is permitted without permission of the translator. For any questions or comments please contact Ian Johnston. Note that in the following text, the words within square brackets have been added by the translator. The numbers in curved brackets indicate links to explanatory endnotes provided by the translator.] If you would like to download a Rich Text Format text of this text, please use the following link: Genealogy 2 [RTF] Second Essay Guilt, Bad Conscience, and Related Matters 1 To breed an animal that is entitled to make promises—is that not precisely the paradoxical task nature has set itself where human beings are concerned? Isn’t that the real problem of human beings? . . . The fact that this problem has to a great extent been solved must seem all the more astonishing to a person who knows how to appreciate fully the power which works against this promise-making, namely forgetfulness. Forgetfulness is not merely a vis inertiae [a force of inertia], as superficial people think. Is it much rather an active capability to repress, something positive in the strongest sense, to which we can ascribe the fact that while we are digesting what we alone live through and experience and absorb into ourselves (we could call the process mental ingestion [Einverseelung]), we are conscious of what is going

on as little as we are with the entire thousand-fold process which our bodily nourishment goes through (so-called physical ingestion [Einverleibung]). The doors and windows of consciousness are shut temporarily; they remain undisturbed by the noise and struggle with which the underworld of our functional organs keeps working for and against one another; a little stillness, a little tabula rasa [blank slate] of the consciousness, so that there will again be room for something new, above all, for the nobler functions and officials, for ruling, thinking ahead, determining what to do (for our organism is arranged as an oligarchy)—that is, as I said, the use of active forgetfulness, a porter at the door, so to speak, a custodian of psychic order, quiet, etiquette. From that we can see at once how, if forgetfulness were not present, there could be no happiness, no cheerfulness, no hoping, no pride, no present. The man in whom this repression apparatus is harmed and not working properly we can compare to a dyspeptic (and not just compare)—he is “finished” with nothing. . . . Now, this particular animal, which is necessarily forgetful, in which forgetfulness is present as a force, as a form of strong health, has had an opposing capability bred into it, a memory, with the help of which, in certain cases, forgetfulness will cease to function—that is, for those cases where promises are to be made. This is in no way a merely passive inability ever to be rid of an impression once it has been etched into the mind, nor is it merely indigestion over a word one has pledged at a particular time and which one can no longer be over and done with. No, it’s an active wish not to be free of the matter again, an ongoing and continuing desire for what one willed at a particular time, a real memory of one’s will, so that between the original “I will,” “I will do,” and the actual discharge of the will, its action, a world of strange w things, circumstances, even acts of the will can be interposed without a second thought and not break this long chain of the will. But how much all that presupposes! In order to organize the future in this manner, human beings must have first learned to separate necessary events from chance events, to think in terms of cause and effect, to see distant events as if they were present, to anticipate them, to set goals and the means to reach them with certainty, to develop a capability for figures and calculations in general—and for that to occur, a human being must necessarily have first himself become something one could predict, something bound by regular rules, even in the way he imagined himself to himself, so that finally he is able to act like someone who makes promises—he can make himself into a pledge for the future! 2 Precisely that development is the long history of the origin of responsibility. That task of breeding an animal which is permitted to make promises contains within it, as we have already grasped, as a condition and prerequisite, the more precise task of first making a human being necessarily uniform to some extent, one among others like him, regular and consequently predictable. The immense task involved in this, what I have called the “morality of custom” (cf. Daybreak 9, 14,

16)—the essential work of a man on his own self in the longest-lasting age of the human race, his entire pre-historical work, derives its meaning, its grand justification, from the following point, no matter how much hardship, tyranny, monotony, and idiocy it also manifested: with the help of the morality of custom and the social strait jacket, the human being was made truly predictable. Let's position ourselves, by contrast, at the end of this immense process, in the place where the tree at last yields its fruit, where society and the morality of custom finally bring to light the end for which they were simply the means: then we find, as the ripest fruit on that tree, the sovereign individual, something which resembles only itself, which has broken loose again from the morality of custom, the autonomous individual beyond morality (for "autonomous" and "moral" are mutually exclusive terms), in short, the human being who possesses his own independent and enduring will, who is entitled to make promises—and in him a consciousness quivering in every muscle, proud of what has finally been achieved and has become a living embodiment in him, a real consciousness of power and freedom, a feeling of completion for human beings generally. This man who has become free, who really is entitled to make promises, this master of free will, this sovereign—how is he not to realize the superiority he enjoys over everything which is not permitted to make a promise and make pledges on its own behalf, knowing how much trust, how much fear, and how much respect he creates—he "is worthy" of all three—and how, with this mastery over himself, he has necessarily been given in addition mastery over his circumstances, over nature, and over all less reliable creatures with a shorter will? The "free" man, the owner of an enduring unbreakable will, by possessing this, also acquires his own standard of value: he looks out from himself at others and confers respect or contempt. And just as it will be necessary for him to honour those like him, the strong and dependable (who are entitled to make promises)—in other words, everyone who makes promises like a sovereign, seriously, rarely, and slowly, who is sparing with his trust, who honours another when he does trust, who gives his word as something reliable, because he knows he is strong enough to remain upright even when opposed by misfortune, even when "opposed by fate"—in just the same way it will be necessary for him to keep his foot ready to kick the scrawny unreliable men, who make promises without being entitled to, and to hold his cane ready for the liar, who breaks his word in the very moment it comes out of his mouth. The proud knowledge of the extraordinary privilege of responsibility, the consciousness of this rare freedom, of this power over oneself and destiny, has become internalized into the deepest parts of him and grown instinctual, has become an instinct, a dominating instinct:—what will he call it, this dominating instinct, assuming that he finds he needs a word for it? There's no doubt: the sovereign man calls this instinct his conscience. 3 His conscience? . . . To begin with, we can conjecture that the idea "conscience,"

which we are encountering here in its highest, almost perplexing form, has a long history and changing developmental process behind it already. To be entitled to pledge one's word, and to do it with pride, and also to be permitted to say "Yes" to oneself—that is a ripe fruit, as I have mentioned, but it is also a late fruit:—for what a long stretch of time this fruit must have hung tart and sour on the tree! And for an even much longer time it was impossible to see any such fruit—no one could have promised it would appear, even if everything about the tree was certainly getting ready for it and growing in that very direction!—"How does one create a memory for the human animal? How does one stamp something like that into this partly dull, partly flickering, momentary understanding, this living embodiment of forgetfulness, so that it stays current?" . . . This ancient problem, as you can imagine, was not resolved right away with tender answers and methods. Indeed, there is perhaps nothing more fearful and more terrible in the entire prehistory of human beings than the technique for developing his memory. "We burn something in so that it remains in the memory. Only something which never ceases to cause pain remains in the memory"—that is a leading principle of the most ancient (unfortunately also the longest) psychology on earth. We might even say that everywhere on earth nowadays where there is still solemnity, seriousness, mystery, and gloomy colours in the lives of men and people, something of that terror continues its work, the fear with which in earlier times everywhere on earth people made promises, pledged their word, made a vow. The past, the longest, deepest, most severe past, breathes on us and surfaces in us when we become "solemn." When the human being considered it necessary to make a memory for himself, it never happened without blood, martyrs, and sacrifices, the most terrible sacrifices and pledges (among them the sacrifice of the first born), the most repulsive self-mutilations (for example, castration), the cruellest forms of ritual in all the religious cults (and all religions are in their deepest foundations systems of cruelty)—all that originates in that instinct which discovered in pain the most powerful means of helping to develop the memory. In a certain sense all asceticism belongs here: a couple of ideas are to be made indissoluble, omnipresent, unforgettable, "fixed," in order to hypnotize the entire nervous and intellectual system through these "fixed ideas"—and the ascetic procedures and forms of life are the means whereby these ideas are freed from jostling around with all the other ideas, in order to make them "unforgettable." The worse humanity's "memory" was, the more terrible its customs have always appeared. The harshness of the laws of punishment, in particular, provide a standard for measuring how much trouble people went to in order to triumph over forgetfulness and to maintain a present awareness of a few primitive demands of social living together for this slave of momentary feelings and desires. We Germans certainly do not think of ourselves as an especially cruel and hard-hearted people, even less as particularly careless people who live only

in the present. But just take a look at our old penal code in order to understand how much trouble it takes on this earth to breed a “People of Thinkers” (by that I mean the European people among whom today we still find a maximum of trust, seriousness, tastelessness, and practicality, and who, with these characteristics, have a right to breed all sorts of European mandarins). These Germans have used terrible means to make themselves a memory in order to attain mastery over their vulgar basic instincts and their brutal crudity: think of the old German punishments, for example, stoning (—the legend even lets the mill stone fall on the head of the guilty person), breaking on the wheel (the most characteristic invention and specialty of the German genius in the realm of punishment!), impaling on a stake, ripping people apart or stamping them to death with horses (“quartering”), boiling the criminal in oil or wine (still done in the fourteenth and fifteenth centuries), the well-loved practice of flaying (“cutting flesh off in strips”), carving flesh out of the chest, and probably covering the offender with honey and leaving him to the flies in the burning sun. With the help of such images and procedures people finally retained five or six “I will not’s” in the memory, and, so far as these precepts were concerned, they gave their word in order to live with the advantages of society—and it’s true! With the assistance of this sort of memory people finally came to “reason”!—Ah, reason, seriousness, mastery over emotions, this whole gloomy business called reflection, all these privileges and showpieces of human beings: how expensive they were! How much blood and horror is at the bottom of all “good things”! . . . 4 But then how did that other “gloomy business,” the consciousness of guilt, the whole “bad conscience” come into the world?—And with this we turn back to our genealogists of morality. I’ll say it once more—or have I not said anything about it yet?—they are useless. With their own merely “modern” experience extending through only a brief period [fünf Spannen lange], with no knowledge of and no desire to know the past, even less a historical instinct, a “second sight”—something necessary at this very point—they nonetheless pursue the history of morality. That must justifiably produce results which have a less than tenuous relationship to the truth. Have these genealogists of morality up to now allowed themselves to dream, even remotely, that, for instance, that major moral principle “guilt” [Schuld] derived its origin from the very materialistic idea “debt” [Schulden]? Or that punishment developed as a repayment, completely without reference to any assumption about freedom or lack of freedom of the will?—and did so, by contrast, to the point where it always first required a high degree of human development so that the animal “man” began to make those much more primitive distinctions between “intentional,” “negligent,” “accidental,” “responsible,” and their opposites and bring them to bear when meting out punishment? That idea, nowadays so trite, apparently so natural, so unavoidable, which has even had to serve as the explanation how the feeling of

justice in general came into existence on earth, “The criminal deserves punishment because he could have acted otherwise,” this idea is, in fact, an extremely late achievement, indeed, a sophisticated form of human judgment and decision making. Anyone who moves this idea back to the beginnings is sticking his coarse fingers inappropriately into the psychology of older humanity. For the most extensive period of human history, punishment was certainly not meted out because people held the instigator of evil responsible for his actions, and thus it was not assumed that only the guilty party should be punished:—it was much more as it still is now when parents punish their children out of anger over some harm they have suffered, anger vented on the perpetrator—but anger restrained and modified through the idea that every injury has some equivalent and that compensation for it could, in fact, be paid out, even if that is through the pain of the perpetrator. Where did this primitive, deeply rooted, and perhaps by now ineradicable idea derive its power, the idea of an equivalence between punishment and pain? I have already given away the answer: in the contractual relationship between creditor and debtor, which is, in general, as ancient as the idea of “legal subject” and which, for its part, refers back to the basic forms of buying, selling, bartering, trading, and exchanging goods. 5 It’s true that recalling this contractual relationship arouses, as we might initially expect from what I have observed above, all sorts of suspicion of and opposition to older humanity, which established or allowed it. It’s at this particular moment that people make promises. At this very point the pertinent issue is to create a memory for the person who makes a promise, so that precisely here, we can surmise, there will exist a place for harshness, cruelty, and pain. In order to inspire trust in his promise to pay back, in order to give his promise a guarantee of its seriousness and sanctity, in order to impress on his own conscience the idea of paying back as a duty, an obligation, the debtor, by virtue of a contract, pledges to the creditor, in the event that he does not pay, something else that he still “owns,” something else over which he still exercises power, for example, his body or his woman or his freedom or even his life (or, under certain religious conditions, even his blessedness, the salvation of his soul, finally even his peace in the grave, as was the case in Egypt, where the dead body of the debtor even in the tomb found no peace from the creditor—and among the Egyptians, in particular, such peace certainly mattered). That means that the creditor could inflict all kinds of ignominy and torture on the body of the debtor, for instance, slice off the body as much as seemed appropriate for the size of the debt:—and this point of view early on and everywhere gave rise to precise, sometimes horrific estimates going into the smallest detail, legally established estimates about individual limbs and body parts. I consider it already a step forward, as evidence of a freer conception of the law, something which calculates more grandly, a more Roman idea of justice, when Rome’s Twelve Tables of Laws

decreed it was all the same, no matter how much or how little the creditor cut off in such cases: “let it not be thought a crime if they cut off more or less.”⁽¹⁾ Let us clarify for ourselves the logic of this whole method of compensation—it is weird enough. The equivalency is given in this way: instead of an advantage making up directly for the harm (hence, instead of compensation in gold, land, possessions of some sort or another), the creditor is given a kind of pleasure as repayment and compensation—the pleasure of being allowed to discharge his power on a powerless person without having to think about it, the delight in “de fair le mal pour le plaisir de le faire” [doing wrong for the pleasure of doing it], the enjoyment of violation. This enjoyment is more highly prized the lower and baser the creditor stands in the social order, and it can easily seem to him a delicious mouthful, in fact, a foretaste of a higher rank. By means of the “punishment” of the debtor, the creditor participates in a right belonging to the masters. Finally he also for once comes to the lofty feeling of despising a being as someone “beneath him,” as someone he is entitled to mistreat—or at least, in the event that the real force of punishment, of executing punishment, has already been transferred to the “authorities,” the feeling of seeing the debtor despised and mistreated. The compensation thus consists of an order for and a right to cruelty.

6 In this area, that is, in the laws of obligation, the world of the moral concepts “guilt,” “conscience,” “duty,” and “sanctity of obligation” has its origin—its beginning, like the beginning of everything great on earth, was watered thoroughly and for a long time with blood. And can we not add that this world deep down has never again been completely free of a certain smell of blood and torture—(not even with old Kant whose categorical imperative stinks of cruelty)? In addition, here that weird knot linking the ideas of “guilt and suffering,” which perhaps has become impossible to undo, was first knit together. Let me pose the question once more: to what extent can suffering be a compensation for “debts”? To the extent that making someone suffer provides the highest degree of pleasure, to the extent that the person hurt by the debt, in exchange for the injury as well as for the distress caused by the injury, got an extraordinary offsetting pleasure: creating suffering—a real celebration, something that, as I’ve said, was valued all the more, the greater it contradicted the rank and social position of the creditor. I have been speculating here, for it’s difficult to see through to the foundations of such subterranean things, quite apart from the fact that it’s embarrassing. And anyone who crudely throws into the middle of all this the idea of “revenge” has buried and dimmed his insights rather than illuminated them (—revenge itself, in fact, simply takes us back to the same problem: “How can making someone suffer give us a feeling of satisfaction?”). It seems to me that the delicacy and, even more, the *Tartufferie* [hypocrisy] of tame house pets (I mean modern man, I mean us) resist imagining with all our power how much cruelty contributes to the great celebratory joy of older humanity, as, in fact, an

ingredient mixed into almost all their enjoyments and, from another perspective, how naive, how innocent, their need for cruelty appears, how they fundamentally think of its particular “disinterested malice” (or to use Spinoza’s words, the *sympathia malevolens* [malevolent sympathy]) as a normal human characteristic:—and hence as something to which their conscience says a heartfelt Yes!(2) A more deeply penetrating eye might still notice, even today, enough of this most ancient and most fundamental celebratory human joy. In *Beyond Good and Evil*, 229 (even earlier in *Daybreak*, 18, 77, 113), I pointed a cautious finger at the constantly growing spiritualization and “deification” of cruelty, which runs through the entire history of higher culture (and, in a significant sense, even constitutes that culture). In any case, it’s not so long ago that people wouldn’t think of an aristocratic wedding and folk festival in the grandest style without executions, tortures, or something like an *auto-da-fé* [burning at the stake], and similarly no noble household lacked creatures on whom people could vent their malice and cruel taunts without a second thought (—remember, for instance, Don Quixote at the court of the duchess; today we read all of Don Quixote with a bitter taste on the tongue; it’s almost an ordeal. In so doing, we would become very foreign, very obscure to the author and his contemporaries—they read it with a fully clear conscience as the most cheerful of books. They almost died laughing at it). Watching suffering makes people feel good; creating suffering makes them feel even better—that’s a harsh principle, but an old, powerful, and human, all-too-human major principle, which, by the way, even the apes might perhaps agree with as well. For people say that, in thinking up bizarre cruelties, the apes already anticipate a great many human actions and are, as it were, an “audition.” Without cruelty there is no celebration: that’s what the oldest and longest human history teaches us—and with punishment, too, there is so much celebration! 7 With these ideas, by the way, I have no desire whatsoever to give our pessimists grist for their discordant mills grating with weariness of life. On the contrary, I want to state very clearly that in that period when human beings had not yet become ashamed of their cruelty, life on earth was happier than it is today, now that we have our pessimists. The darkening of heaven over men’s heads has always increased alarmingly in proportion to the growth of human beings’ shame before human beings. The tired, pessimistic look, the mistrust of the riddle of life, the icy denial stemming from disgust with life—these are not the signs of the wickedest eras of human beings. It’s much more the case that they first come to light as the swamp plants they are when the swamp to which they belong is there—I mean the sickly mollycoddling and moralizing, thanks to which the animal “man” finally learns to feel shame about all his instincts. On his way to becoming an “angel” (not to use a harsher word here), man cultivated for himself that upset stomach and that furry tongue which not only made the joy and innocence of the animal repulsive but also made life itself distasteful:—so

that now and then he stands there before himself, holds his nose, and with Pope Innocent III disapproves and makes a catalogue of his nastiness (“conceived in filth, disgustingly nourished in his mother’s body, developed out of evil material stuff, stinking horribly, a secretion of spit, urine, and excrement”).(3) Now, when suffering always has to march out as the first among the arguments against existence, as its most serious question mark, it’s good for us to remember the times when people judged things the other way around, because they couldn’t do without making people suffer and saw a first-class magic in it, a really tempting enticement for living. Perhaps, and let me say this as a consolation for the delicate, at that time pain did not yet hurt as much as it does nowadays. That at least could be the conclusion of a doctor who had treated a Negro (taking the latter as a representative of pre-historical man) for a bad case of inner inflammation, which drives the European, even one with the best constitution, almost to despair, but which does not have the same effect on the Negro. (The graph of the human sensitivity to pain seems in fact to sink down remarkably and almost immediately after one has moved beyond the first ten thousand or ten million of the top members of the higher culture. And I personally have no doubt that, in comparison with one painful night of a single hysterical well-educated female, the total suffering of all animals which up to now have been interrogated by the knife in search of scientific answers is simply not worth considering). Perhaps it is even permissible to concede the possibility that that pleasure in cruelty does not really need to have died out. It would only require a certain sublimation and subtlety, in proportion to the way pain hurts more nowadays; in other words, it would have to appear translated into the imaginative and spiritual and embellished with nothing but names so unobjectionable that they arouse no suspicion in even the most delicate hypocritical conscience (“tragic pity” is one such name; another is “les nostalgies de la croix” [nostalgias for the cross]). What truly enrages people about suffering is not the suffering itself, but the meaninglessness of suffering. But neither for the Christian, who has interpreted into suffering an entire secret machinery for salvation, nor for the naive men of older times, who understood how to interpret all suffering in relation to the spectator or to the person inflicting the suffering, was there generally any such meaningless suffering. In order for the hidden, undiscovered, unwitnessed suffering to be removed from the world and for people to be able to deny it honestly, they were then almost compelled to invent gods and intermediate beings at all levels, high and low—briefly put, something that also roamed in hidden places, that also looked into the darkness, and that would not readily permit an interesting painful spectacle to escape its attention. For with the help of such inventions life then understood and has always understood how to justify itself by a trick, how to justify its “evil.” Nowadays perhaps it requires other helpful inventions for that purpose (for example, life as riddle, life as a problem

of knowledge). “Every evil a glimpse of which edifies a god is justified”: that’s how the pre-historical logic of feeling rang out—and was that really confined only to prehistory? The gods conceived of as friends of cruel spectacle—O how widely this primitive idea still rises up even within our European humanity! We might well seek advice from, say, Calvin and Luther on this point. At any rate it is certain that even the Greeks knew of no more acceptable snack to offer their gods to make them happy than the joys of cruelty. With what sort of expression, do you think, did Homer allow his gods to look down on the fates of men? What final sense was there basically in the Trojan War and similar tragic terrors? We cannot entertain the slightest doubts about this: they were intended as celebrations for the gods: and, to the extent that the poet is in these matters more “godlike” than other men, as festivals for the poets as well. . . . Later the Greek moral philosophers in the same way imagined the eyes of god no differently, still looking down on the moral struggles, on heroism and the self-mutilation of the virtuous: the “Hercules of duty” was on a stage, and he knew he was there. Without someone watching, virtue for this race of actors was something entirely inconceivable. Surely such a daring and fateful philosophical invention, first made for Europe at that time, the invention of the “free will,” of the absolutely spontaneous nature of human beings in matters of good and evil, was created above all to justify the idea that the interest of gods in men, in human virtue, could never run out? On this earthly stage there was never to be any lack of really new things, really unheard of suspense, complications, and catastrophes. A world conceived of as perfectly deterministic would have been predictable to the gods and therefore also soon boring for them—reason enough for these friends of the gods, the philosophers, not to ascribe such a deterministic world to their gods! All of ancient humanity is full of sensitive consideration for “the spectator,” for a truly public, truly visible world, which did not know how to imagine happiness without dramatic performances and festivals. And, as I have already said, in great punishment there is also so much celebration! 8 To resume the path of our enquiry, the feeling of guilt, of personal obligation has, as we saw, its origin in the oldest and most primitive personal relationship there is, in the relationship between seller and buyer, creditor and debtor. Here for the first time one person moved up against another person, here an individual measured himself against another individual. We have found no civilization still at such a low level that something of this relationship is not already perceptible. To set prices, to measure values, to think up equivalencies, to exchange things—that preoccupied man’s very first thinking to such a degree that in a certain sense it’s what thinking itself is. Here the oldest form of astuteness was bred; here, too, we can assume are the first beginnings of man’s pride, his feeling of pre-eminence in relation to other animals. Perhaps our word “man” (*manas*) continues to express directly something of this feeling of the self: the human being describes himself

as a being which assesses values, which values and measures, as the “inherently calculating animal.” Selling and buying, together with their psychological attributes, are even older than the beginnings of any form of social organizations and groupings; out of the most rudimentary form of personal legal rights the budding feeling of exchange, contract, guilt, law, duty, and compensation was instead first transferred to the crudest and earliest social structures (in their relationships with similar social structures), along with the habit of comparing power with power, of measuring, of calculating. The eye was now adjusted to this perspective, and with that awkward consistency characteristic of thinking in more ancient human beings, hard to get started but then inexorably moving forward in the same direction, people soon reached the great generalization: “Each thing has its price, everything can be paid off”—the oldest and most naive moral principle of justice, the beginning of all “good nature,” all “fairness,” all “good will,” all “objectivity” on earth. Justice at this first stage is good will among those approximately equal in power to come to terms with each other, to “come to an agreement” again with each other by compensation—and in relation to those less powerful, to compel them to arrive at some settlement among themselves.— 9 Always measured by the standard of prehistory (a prehistory which, by the way, is present at all times or is capable of returning), the community also stands in relation to its members in that important basic relationship of the creditor to his debtor. People live in a community. They enjoy the advantages of a community (and what advantages they are! Nowadays we sometimes underestimate them); they live protected, cared for, in peace and trust, without worries concerning certain injuries and enmities from which the man outside the community, the “man without peace,” is excluded—a German understands what “misery” [Elend] or *êlend* [other country] originally means—and how people pledged themselves to and entered into obligations with the community bearing in mind precisely these injuries and enmities. What will happen with an exception to this case? The community, the defrauded creditor, will see that it gets paid as well as it can—on that people can rely. The issue here is least of all the immediate damage which the offender has caused. Setting this to one side, the lawbreaker [Verbrecher] is above all a “breaker” [Brecher], a breaker of contracts and a breaker of his word against the totality, with respect to all the good features and advantages of the communal life in which, up to that point, he has had a share. The lawbreaker is a debtor who does not merely not pay back the benefits and advances given to him, but who even attacks his creditor. So from this point on not only does he forfeit, as is reasonable, all these good things and benefits—but he is also now reminded what these good things are all about. The anger of the injured creditor, the community, gives him back again to the wild outlawed condition, from which he was earlier protected. It pushes him away from itself—and now every form of hostility can vent itself on

him. At this stage of cultural behaviour “punishment” is simply the copy, the *mimus*, of the normal conduct towards the hated, disarmed enemy who has been thrown down, who has forfeited not only all legal rights and protection but also all mercy; hence it is a case of the rights of war and the victory celebration of *vae victis* [woe to the conquered] in all its ruthlessness and cruelty:—which accounts for the fact that war itself (including the warlike cult of sacrifice) has given us all the forms in which punishment has appeared in history. 10 As it acquires more power, a community no longer considers the crimes of the single individual so serious, because it no longer is entitled to consider him as dangerous and unsettling for the existence of the totality as much as it did before. The wrongdoer is no longer “outlawed” and thrown out, and the common anger is no longer permitted to vent itself on him without restraint to the same extent as earlier—instead the wrongdoer from now on is carefully protected by the community against this anger, especially from that of the immediately injured person, and is taken into protective custody. The compromise with the anger of those particularly affected by the wrong doing, and thus the effort to localize the case and to avert a wider or even a general participation and unrest, the attempts to find equivalents and to settle the whole business (the *compositio*), above all the desire, appearing with ever-increasing clarity, to consider every crime as, in some sense or other, capable of being paid off, and thus, at least to a certain extent, to separate the criminal and his crime from each other—those are the characteristics stamped more and more clearly on the further development of criminal law. If the power and the self-confidence of a community keep growing, the criminal law also grows constantly milder. Every weakening and deeper jeopardizing of the community brings its harsher forms of criminal law to light once again. The “creditor” has always become proportionally more humane as he has become richer. Finally the amount of his wealth even becomes measured by how much damage he can sustain without suffering from it. It would not be impossible to imagine a society with a consciousness of its own power which allowed itself the most privileged luxury which it can have—letting its criminals go without punishment. “Why should I really bother about my parasites?” it could then say. “May they live and prosper; for that I am still sufficiently strong!” . . . Justice, which started with “Everything is capable of being paid for; everything must be paid off” ends at that point, by shutting its eyes and letting the person incapable of payment go free—it ends, as every good thing on earth ends, by doing away with itself. This self-negation of justice: we know what a beautiful name it calls itself—mercy. It goes without saying that mercy remains the privilege of the most powerful man, or even better, his beyond the law. 11 A critical comment here about a recently published attempt to find the origin of justice in a completely different place—that is, in resentment. But first a word in the ear of the psychologists, provided that they have any desire to study

resentment itself up close for once: this plant grows most beautifully nowadays among anarchists and anti-Semites; in addition, it blooms, as it always has, in hidden places, like the violet, although it has a different fragrance.(4) And since like always has to emerge necessarily from like, it is not surprising to see attempts coming forward again from just such circles, as they have already done many times before—see above, Section 14 [First Essay]—to sanctify revenge under the name of justice—as if justice were basically only a further development of a feeling of being injured—and to bring belated honour to reactive emotions generally, all of them, using the idea of revenge. With this last point I personally take the least offence. It even seems to me a service, so far as the entire biological problem is concerned (in connection with which the worth of those emotions has been underestimated up to now). The only thing I am calling attention to is the fact that it is the very spirit of resentment out of which this new emphasis on scientific fairness grows (which favours hate, envy, resentment, suspicion, rancour, and revenge). This “scientific fairness,” that is, ceases immediately and gives way to tones of mortal enmity and prejudice as soon as it deals with another group of emotions which, it strikes me, have a much higher biological worth than those reactive ones and which therefore have earned the right to be scientifically assessed and respected first—namely, the truly active emotions, like desire for mastery, acquisitiveness, and so on (E. Dühring, *The Value of Life: A Course in Philosophy*, the whole book really).(5) So much against this tendency in general. But in connection with Dühring’s single principle that we have to seek the homeland of justice in the land of the reactive feeling, we must, for love of the truth, rudely turn this around by setting out a different principle: the last territory to be conquered by the spirit of justice is the land of the reactive emotions! If it is truly the case that the just man remains just even towards someone who has injured him (and not merely cold, moderate, strange, indifferent: being just is always a positive attitude), if under the sudden attack of personal injury, ridicule, and suspicion, the gaze of the lofty, clear objectivity of the just and judging eye, as profound as it is benevolent, does not itself grow dark, well, that’s a piece of perfection and the highest mastery on earth—even something that it would be wise for people not to expect here; in any event, they should not believe in it too easily. It’s certainly true that, on average, among the most just people themselves even a small dose of hostility, malice, and insinuation is enough to make them see red and chase fairness out of their eyes. The active, aggressive, over-reaching human being is still placed a hundred steps closer to justice than the reactive person. For him it is simply not necessary in the slightest to estimate an object falsely and with bias, the way the reactive man does and must do. Thus, as a matter of fact, at all times the aggressive human being, as the stronger, braver, more noble man, has had on his side a better conscience as well as a more independent eye; by contrast, we can already

guess who generally has the invention of “bad conscience” on his conscience—the man of resentment! Finally, let’s look around in history: up to now in what area has the whole implementation of law in general as well as the essential need for law been at home on earth? Could it be in the area of the reactive human beings? That is entirely wrong. It is much more the case that it’s been at home with the active, strong, spontaneous, and aggressive men. Historically considered, the law on earth—let me say this to the annoyance of the above-mentioned agitator (who once even confessed about himself “The doctrine of revenge runs through all my work and efforts as the red thread of justice”)—represents that very struggle against the reactive feelings, the war with them on the part of active and aggressive powers, which have partly used up their strength to put a halt to or to restrain the excess of reactive pathos and to compel some settlement with it. Wherever justice is practised, wherever justice is upheld, we see a stronger power in relation to a weaker power standing beneath it (whether with groups or individuals), seeking ways to bring an end among the latter to the senseless rage of resentment, partly by dragging the object of resentment out of the hands of revenge, partly by setting in the place of revenge a battle against the enemies of peace and order, partly by coming up with compensation, proposing it, under certain circumstances making it compulsory, partly by establishing certain equivalents for injuries as a norm, into which from now on resentment is directed once and for all. The most decisive factor, however, which the highest power carries out and sets in place against the superior numbers of the feelings of hostility and animosity—something that power always does as soon as it is somehow strong enough to do it—is to set up law, the imperative explanation of those things which, in its own eyes, are generally considered allowed and legal and things which are considered forbidden and illegal, while after the establishment of the law, the authorities treat attacks and arbitrary acts of individuals or entire groups as an outrage against the law, as rebellion against the highest power itself, and they steer the feeling of those beneath them away from the immediate damage caused by such outrages and thus, in the long run, achieve the reverse of what all revenge desires, which sees only the viewpoint of the injured party and considers only that valid. From now on, the eye becomes trained to evaluate actions always impersonally, even the eye of the harmed party itself (although this would be the very last thing to occur, as I have remarked earlier).—Consequently, only with the setting up of the law is there a “just” and “unjust” (and not, as Dühring will have it, from the time of the injurious action). To talk of just and unjust in themselves has no sense whatsoever; it’s obvious that in themselves harming, oppressing, exploiting, destroying cannot be “unjust,” inasmuch as life essentially works that way, that is, in its basic functions it harms, oppresses, exploits, and destroys, and cannot be conceived at all without this character. We have to acknowledge something even

more disturbing: the fact that from the highest biological standpoint, conditions of justice must always be only exceptional conditions, partial restrictions on the basic will to live, which is set on power; they are subordinate to the total purpose of this will as individual means, that is, as means to create larger units of power. A legal system conceived of as sovereign and universal, not as a means in the struggle of power complexes, but as a means against all struggles in general, something along the lines of Dühring's communist cliché in which each will must be considered as equal to every will, that would be a principle hostile to life, a destroyer and dissolver of human beings, an assassination attempt on the future of human beings, a sign of exhaustion, a secret path to nothingness.— 12

Here one more word concerning the origin and purpose of punishment—two problems which are separate or should be separate. Unfortunately people normally throw them together into one. How do the previous genealogists of morality deal with this issue? Naively—the way they have always worked. They find some “purpose” or other for punishment, for example, revenge or deterrence, then in a simple way set this purpose at the beginning as the *causa fiendi* [creative cause] of punishment and—they're finished. The “purpose in law,” however, is the very last idea we should use in the history of the emergence of law. It is much rather the case that for all forms of history there is no more important principle than that one which we reach with such difficulty but which we also really should reach—namely that what causes a particular thing to arise and the final utility of that thing, its actual use and arrangement in a system of purposes, are separate *toto coelo* [by all the heavens, i.e., absolutely] from each other, that something existing, which has somehow come to its present state, will again and again be interpreted by the higher power over it from a new perspective, appropriated in a new way, reorganized for and redirected to new uses, that all events in the organic world involve overpowering, acquiring mastery and that, in turn, all overpowering and acquiring mastery involve a new interpretation, a readjustment, in which the “sense” and “purpose” up to then must necessarily be obscured or entirely erased. No matter how well we have understood the usefulness of some physiological organ or other (or a legal institution, a social custom, a political practice, some style in the arts or in a religious cult), we have still not, in that process, grasped anything about its origin—no matter how uncomfortable and unpleasant this may sound in elderly ears. From time immemorial people have believed that in demonstrable purposes, in the usefulness of a thing, a form, or an institution, they could also understand the reason it came into existence—the eye as something made to see, the hand as something made to grasp. So people also imagined punishment as invented to punish. But all purposes, all uses, are only signs that a will to power has become master over something with less power and has stamped on it its own meaning of some function, and the entire history of a “thing,” an organ, a practice can by this

process be seen as a continuing chain of signs of constantly new interpretations and adjustments, whose causes do not even need to be connected to each other—in some circumstances they rather follow and take over from each other by chance. Consequently, the “development” of a thing, a practice, or an organ has nothing to do with its progressus [progress] towards a single goal, even less is it the logical and shortest progressus reached with the least expenditure of power and resources—but rather the sequence of more or less profound, more or less mutually independent processes of overpowering which take place on that thing, together with the resistance which arises against that overpowering each time, the changes of form which have been attempted for the purpose of defence and reaction, as well as the results of successful counter-measures. Form is fluid; the “meaning,” however, is even more so. . . . Even within each individual organism things are no different: with every essential growth in the totality, the “meaning” of the individual organ also shifts—in certain circumstances its partial destruction, a reduction of its numbers (for example, through the obliteration of intermediate structures) can be a sign of growing power and perfection. What I wanted to say is this: the partial loss of utility, decline, and degeneration, the loss of meaning, and purposiveness, in short, death, also belong to the conditions of a real progressus [progress], which always appears in the form of a will and a way to a greater power and always establishes itself at the expense of a huge number of smaller powers. The size of a “step forward” can even be estimated by a measure of everything that had to be sacrificed to it. The humanity as mass sacrificed for the benefit of a single stronger species of man—that would be a step forward I emphasize this major point of view about historical methodology all the more since it basically runs counter to the very instinct which presently rules and to contemporary taste, which would rather still go along with the absolute contingency, even the mechanical meaninglessness, of all events rather than with the theory of a will to power playing itself out in everything that happens. The democratic idiosyncrasy of being hostile to everything which rules and wants to rule, the modern hatred of rulers [Misarchismus] (to make up a bad word for a bad thing) has gradually transformed itself into and dressed itself up as something spiritual, of the highest spirituality, to such an extent that nowadays step by step it is already infiltrating the strictest, apparently most objective scientific research, and is allowed to infiltrate it. Indeed, it seems to me already to have attained mastery over all of physiology and the understanding of life, to their detriment, as is obvious, because it has conjured away from them their fundamental concept, that of real activity. By contrast, under the pressure of this idiosyncrasy we push “adaptation” into the foreground, that is, a second-order activity, a mere reactivity; in fact, people have defined life itself as an always purposeful inner adaptation to external circumstances (Herbert Spencer). But that simply

misjudges the essence of life, its will to power. That overlooks the first priority of the spontaneous, aggressive, over-reaching, re-interpreting, re-directing, and shaping powers, after whose effects the “adaptation” then follows. Thus, the governing role of the highest functions in an organism itself, the ones in which the will for living appear active and creative, are denied. People should remember the criticism Huxley directed at Spencer for his “administrative nihilism.” But the issue here concerns much more than “administration”. . . (6)

13 Returning to the business at hand, that is, to punishment, we have to differentiate between two aspects of it: first its relative duration, the way it is carried out, the action, the “drama,” a certain strict sequence of procedures and, on the other hand, its fluidity, the meaning, the purpose, the expectation linked to the implementation of such procedures. In this matter, we can here assume, without further comment, per analogium [by analogy], in accordance with the major viewpoints about the historical method we have just established, that the procedure itself will be somewhat older and earlier than its use as a punishment, that the latter was only first injected and interpreted into the procedure (which had been present for a long time but was a custom with a different meaning), in short, that it was not what our naive genealogists of morality and law up to now have assumed, who collectively imagined that the procedure was invented for the purpose of punishment, just as people earlier thought that the hand was invented for the purpose of grasping. Now, so far as that other element in punishment is concerned, the fluid element, its “meaning,” in a very late cultural state (for example in contemporary Europe) the idea of “punishment” actually presents not simply one meaning but a whole synthesis of “meanings.” The history of punishment up to now, in general, the history of its use for different purposes, finally crystallizes into a sort of unity, which is difficult to untangle, difficult to analyze, and, it must be stressed, totally incapable of definition. (Today it is impossible to say clearly why we really punish; all ideas in which an entire process is semiotically summarized elude definition. Only something which has no history is capable of being defined). At an earlier stage, by contrast, that synthesis of “meanings” still appears easier to untangle, as well as even easier to adjust. We can still see how in every individual case the elements in the synthesis alter their valence and rearrange themselves accordingly, so that soon this or that element steps forward and dominates at the expense of the rest; indeed, under certain circumstances one element (say, the purpose of deterrence) appears to rise above all the other elements. In order to give at least an idea of how uncertain, how belated, how accidental “the meaning” of punishment is and how one and the same procedure can be used, interpreted, or adjusted for fundamentally different purposes, let me offer here an example which presented itself to me on the basis of relatively little random material: punishment as a way of rendering someone harmless, as a prevention from further harm; punishment as

compensation for the damage to the person injured, in some form or other (also in the form of emotional compensation); punishment as isolation of some upset to an even balance in order to avert a wider outbreak of the disturbance; punishment as way of inspiring fear of those who determine and carry out punishment; punishment as a sort of compensation for the advantages which the law breaker has enjoyed up until that time (for example, when he is made useful as a slave working in the mines); punishment as a cutting out of a degenerate element (in some circumstances an entire branch, as in Chinese law, and thus a means to keep the race pure or to sustain a social type); punishment as festival, that is, as the violation and humiliation of some enemy one has finally thrown down; punishment as a way of making a conscience, whether for the man who suffers the punishment—so-called “reform”—or whether for those who witness the punishment being carried out; punishment as the payment of an honorarium, set as a condition by those in power, which protects the wrong doer from the excesses of revenge; punishment as a compromise with the natural condition of revenge, insofar as the latter is still upheld and assumed as a privilege by powerful families; punishment as a declaration of war and a war measure against an enemy to peace, law, order, and authority, which people fight with the very measures war makes available, as something dangerous to the community, as a breach of contract with respect to its conditions, as a rebel, traitor, and breaker of the peace. 14 Of course, this list is not complete. Obviously punishment is overloaded with all sorts of useful purposes, all the more reason why people can infer from it an alleged utility, which, in the popular consciousness at least, is considered its most essential one—faith in punishment, which nowadays for several reasons is getting shaky, still finds its most powerful support in precisely that. Punishment is supposed to be valuable in waking the feeling of guilt in the guilty party. In punishment people are looking for the actual instrument for that psychic reaction called “bad conscience,” “pangs of conscience.” But in doing this, people are misappropriating reality and psychology, even for today, and how much more for the longest history of man, his prehistory! Real pangs of conscience are something extremely rare, especially among criminals and prisoners. Prisons and penitentiaries are not breeding grounds in which this species of gnawing worm particularly likes to thrive:—on that point all conscientious observers agree, in many cases delivering such a judgment with sufficient unwillingness, going against their own desires. In general, punishment makes people hard and cold. It concentrates. It sharpens the feeling of estrangement; it strengthens powers of resistance. If it comes about that punishment shatters a man’s energy and brings on a wretched prostration and self-abasement, such a consequence is surely even less pleasant than the typical result of punishment, characteristically a dry, gloomy seriousness. However, if we consider those thousands of years before the history of humanity, without a

second thought we can conclude that the very development of a feeling of guilt was most powerfully hindered by punishment—at least with respect to the victims onto whom this force of punishment was vented. For let us not underestimate just how much the criminal is prevented by the very sight of judicial and executive procedures themselves from sensing that his act, the nature of his action, is something inherently reprehensible, for he sees exactly the same kind of actions committed in the service of justice, then applauded and practised in good conscience, like espionage, lying, bribery, entrapment, the whole tricky and sly art of the police and prosecution, as it manifests itself in the various kinds of punishment—the robbery, oppression, abuse, imprisonment, torture, murder, all done, moreover, as a matter of principle, without even any emotional involvement as an excuse—all these actions are in no way rejected or condemned in themselves by his judges, but only in particular respects when used for certain purposes. “Bad conscience,” this most creepy and most interesting plant among our earthly vegetation, did not grow in this soil—in fact, for the longest period in the past nothing about dealing with a “guilty party” penetrated the consciousness of judges or even those doing the punishing. By contrast, they were dealing with someone who had caused harm, with an irresponsible piece of fate. And even the man on whom punishment later fell, once again like a piece of fate, experienced in that no “inner pain,” other than what might have come from the sudden arrival of something unpredictable, a terrible natural event, a falling, crushing boulder against which there is no way to fight any more. 15 At one point Spinoza became aware of this issue in an incriminating way (something which irritates his interpreters, like Kuno Fischer, who really go to great lengths to misunderstand him on this matter), when one afternoon, he came up against some memory or other (who knows what?) and pondered the question about what, as far as he was concerned, was left of the celebrated *morsus conscientiae* [the bite of conscience]—for him, the man who had expelled good and evil into human fantasies and had irascibly defended the honour of his “free” God against those blasphemers who claimed that in everything God worked *sub ratione boni* [with good reason] (“but that means that God would be subordinate to Fate, a claim which, in truth, would be the greatest of all contradictions”). For Spinoza the world had gone back again into that state of innocence in which it had existed before the invention of bad conscience. So with that what, then, had become of the *morsus conscientiae*? “The opposite of *gaudium* [joy],” Spinoza finally told himself “is sorrow, accompanied by the image of something over and done with which happened contrary to all expectation” (Ethics III, Proposition XVIII, Schol. I. II). In a manner no different from Spinoza’s, those instigating evil who incurred punishment have for thousands of years felt, so far as their “crime” is concerned, “Something has unexpectedly gone awry here,” not “I should not have done that”—they

submitted to their punishment as people submit to a sickness or some bad luck or death, with that brave fatalism free of revolt which, for example, even today gives the Russians an advantage over us westerners in coping with life. If back then there was some criticism of the act, such criticism came from prudence: without question we must seek the essential effect of punishment above all in an increase of prudence, in an extension of memory, in a will to go to work from now on more carefully, more mistrustfully, more secretly, with the awareness that we are in many things definitely too weak, in a kind of improved ability to judge ourselves. In general, what can be achieved through punishment, in human beings and animals, is an increase in fear, a honing of prudence, and control over desires. In the process, punishment tames human beings, but it does not make them “better”—people could with more justification assert the opposite. (Popular wisdom says “Injury makes people prudent,” but to the extent that it makes them prudent, it also makes them bad. Fortunately, often enough it makes people stupid). 16 At this point, I can no longer avoid setting out, in an initial, provisional statement, my own hypothesis about the origin of “bad conscience.” It is not easy to get people to attend to it, and it requires them to consider it at length, to guard it, and to sleep on it. I consider bad conscience the profound illness which human beings had to come down with under the pressure of that most fundamental of all the changes which they ever experienced—that change when they finally found themselves locked within the confines of society and peace. Just like the things water animals must have gone through when they were forced either to become land animals or to die off, so events must have played themselves out with this half-beast so happily adapted to the wilderness, war, wandering around, adventure—suddenly all its instincts were devalued and “disengaged.” From this point on, these animals were to go on foot and “carry themselves”; whereas previously they had been supported by the water. A terrible heaviness weighed them down. In performing the simplest things they felt ungainly. In dealing with this new unknown world, they no longer had their old leaders, the ruling unconscious drives which guided them safely—these unfortunate creatures were reduced to thinking, inferring, calculating, bringing together cause and effect, reduced to their “consciousness,” their most impoverished and error-prone organ! I believe that never on earth has there been such a feeling of misery, such a leaden discomfort—while at the same time those old instincts had not all of a sudden stopped imposing their demands! Only it was difficult and seldom possible to do their bidding. For the most part, they had to find new and, as it were, underground satisfactions for themselves. All instincts which are not discharged to the outside are turned back inside—this is what I call the internalization [Verinnerlichung] of man. From this first grows in man what people later call his “soul.” The entire inner world, originally as thin as if stretched between two layers of skin, expanded and extended itself, acquired

depth, width, and height, to the extent that what a person discharged out into the world was obstructed. Those frightening fortifications with which the organization of the state protected itself against the old instincts for freedom—punishments belong above all to these fortifications—brought it about that all those instincts of the wild, free, roaming man turned themselves backwards, against man himself. Enmity, cruelty, joy in pursuit, in attack, in change, in destruction—all those turned themselves against the possessors of such instincts. That is the origin of “bad conscience.” The man who, because of a lack of external enemies and opposition, was forced into an oppressive narrowness and regularity of custom impatiently tore himself apart, persecuted himself, gnawed away at himself, grew upset, and did himself damage—this animal which scraped itself raw against the bars of its cage, which people want to “tame,” this impoverished creature, consumed with longing for the wild, which had to create out of its own self an adventure, a torture chamber, an uncertain and dangerous wilderness—this fool, this yearning and puzzled prisoner, became the inventor of “bad conscience.” But with him was introduced the greatest and weirdest illness, from which humanity up to the present time has not recovered, the suffering of man from man, from himself, a consequence of the forcible separation from his animal past, a leap and, so to speak, a fall into new situations and living conditions, a declaration of war against the old instincts, on which, up to that point, his power, joy, and ability to inspire fear had been based. Let us at once add that, on the other hand, the fact that there was on earth an animal soul turned against itself, taking sides against itself, meant there was something so new, profound, unheard of, enigmatic, contradictory, and full of the future, that with it the picture of the earth was fundamentally changed. In fact, it required divine spectators to appreciate the dramatic performance which then began and whose conclusion is by no means yet in sight—a spectacle too fine, too wonderful, too paradoxical, to be allowed to play itself out senselessly and unobserved on some ridiculous star or other! Since then man has been included among the most unexpected and most thrillingly lucky rolls of the dice in the game played by Heraclitus’ “great child,” whether he’s called Zeus or chance.(7) For himself he arouses a certain interest, a tension, a hope, almost a certainty, as if something is announcing itself with him, something is preparing itself, as if the human being were not the goal but only a way, an episode, a bridge, a great promise . . . 17

Inherent in this hypothesis about the origin of bad conscience is, firstly, the assumption that the change was not gradual or voluntary and did not manifest itself as an organic growth into new conditions, but as a break, a leap, something forced, an irrefutable disaster, against which there was no struggle, nor even any resentment. Secondly, however, it assumes that the adaptation of a populace hitherto unchecked and shapeless into a fixed form, just as it was initiated by an act of violence, was carried to its conclusion by nothing but acts of violence—

that consequently the oldest “State” emerged as a terrible tyranny, as an oppressive and inconsiderate machinery, and continued working until such raw materials of people and half-animals finally were not only thoroughly kneaded and submissive but also given a shape. I used the word “State”: it is self-evident who is meant by that term—some pack of blond predatory animals, a race of conquerors and masters, which, organized for war and with the power to organize, without thinking about it, sets its terrifying paws on a subordinate population which may perhaps be vast in numbers but is still without any form, is still wandering about. That is, in fact, the way the “State” begins on earth. I believe that fantasy has been done away with which sees the beginning of the state in a “contract.” The man who can command, who is by nature a “master,” who comes forward with violence in his actions and gestures—what has he to do with making contracts! We do not negotiate with such beings. They come like fate, without cause, reason, consideration, or pretext. They are present as lightning is present, too fearsome, too sudden, too convincing, too “different” even to become merely hated. Their work is the instinctive creation of forms, the imposition of forms. They are the most involuntary and most unconscious artists in existence:—where they appear something new is soon present, a power structure which lives, something in which the parts and functions are demarcated and coordinated, in which there is, in general, no place for anything which does not first derive its “meaning” from its relationship to the totality. These men, these born organizers, have no idea what guilt, responsibility, and consideration are. In them that fearsome egotism of the artist is in charge, which stares out like bronze and knows how to justify itself for all time in the “work,” just as a mother does in her child. They are not the ones in whom “bad conscience” grew—that point is obvious from the outset. But this hateful plant would not have grown without them. It would have failed if an immense amount of freedom had not been driven from the world under the pressure of their hammer blows, their artistic violence, or at least had not been driven from sight and, as it were made latent. This powerful instinct for freedom, once made latent—we already understand how—this instinct for freedom driven back, repressed, imprisoned inside, and finally still able to discharge and direct itself only against itself—that and that alone is what bad conscience is in its beginning. 18 We need to be careful not to entertain a low opinion of this entire phenomenon simply because it is from the start nasty and painful. In fact, it is basically the same active force which is at work on a grander scale in those artists of power and organizers and which builds states. Here it is inner, smaller, more mean spirited, directing itself backwards, into “the labyrinth of the breast,” to use Goethe’s words, and it creates bad conscience for itself and builds negative ideals, just that instinct for freedom (to use my own language, the will to power). Only the material on which the shaping and violating nature of this force directs itself here is simply

man himself, his entire old animal self—and not, as in that greater and more striking phenomenon, on another man or on other men. This furtive violation of the self, this artistic cruelty, this pleasure in giving a shape to oneself as a tough, resisting, suffering material, to burn into it a will, a critique, a contradiction, a contempt, a denial, this weird and horribly pleasurable work of a soul willingly divided against itself, which makes itself suffer for the pleasure of creating suffering, all this active “bad conscience,” as the essential womb of ideal and imaginative events, finally brought to light—we have already guessed—also an abundance of strange new beauty and affirmation and perhaps for the first time the idea of the beautiful in general. . . . For what would be “beautiful,” if its opposite had not yet come to an awareness of itself, if ugliness had not already said to itself, “I am ugly”? At least, after this hint the paradox will be less puzzling, the extent to which in contradictory ideas, like selflessness, self-denial, self-sacrifice, an ideal can be indicated, something beautiful. And beyond that, one thing we do know—I have no doubt about it—namely, the nature of the pleasure which the selfless, self-denying, self-sacrificing person experiences from the beginning: this pleasure belongs to cruelty. So much for the moment on the origin of the “unegoistic” as something of moral worth and on the demarcation of the soil out of which this value has grown: only bad conscience, only the will to abuse the self, provides the condition for the value of the unegoistic. 19 Bad conscience is a sickness—there’s no doubt about that—but a sickness the way pregnancy is a sickness. Let’s look for the conditions in which this illness has arrived at its most terrible and most sublime peak:—in this way we’ll see what really brought about its entry into the world at the start. But that requires a lot of endurance—and we must first go back once more to an earlier point of view. The relationship in civil law between the debtor and his creditor, which I have reviewed extensively already, has been interpreted once again in an extremely remarkable and dubious historical manner into a relationship which we modern men are perhaps least capable of understanding, namely, into the relationship between those people presently alive and their ancestors. Within the original tribal cooperatives—we’re talking about primeval times—the living generation always acknowledged a legal obligation to the previous generations, and especially to the earliest one which had founded the tribe (and this was in no way merely a sentimental obligation: the latter is something we could even reasonably claim was, in general, absent for the longest period of the human race). Here the reigning conviction is that the tribe exists at all only because of the sacrifices and achievements of its ancestors—and that people have to pay them back with sacrifices and achievements. In this people recognize a debt which keeps steadily growing because these ancestors in their continuing existence as powerful spirits do not stop giving the tribe new advantages and lending them their power. Do they do this gratuitously? But there is no

“gratuitously” for those raw and “spiritually destitute” ages. What can people give back to them? Sacrifices (at first as nourishment understood very crudely), festivals, chapels, signs of honour, above all, obedience—for all customs, as work of one’s ancestors, are also their statutes and commands. Do people ever give them enough? This suspicion remains and grows. From time to time it forcefully requires a huge wholesale redemption, something immense as a repayment to the “creditor” (the notorious sacrifice of the first born, for example, blood, human blood in any case). The fear of ancestors and their power, the awareness of one’s debt to them, according to this kind of logic, necessarily increases directly in proportion to the increase in the power of the tribe itself, as the tribe finds itself constantly more victorious, more independent, more honoured, and more feared. It’s not the other way around! Every step towards the decline of the tribe, all conditions of misery, all indications of degeneration, of approaching dissolution, rather lead to a constant lessening of the fear of the spirit of its founder and give a constantly smaller image of his wisdom, providence, and powerful presence. If we think this crude form of logic through to its conclusion, then the ancestors of the most powerful tribes must, because of the fantasy of increasing fear, finally have grown into something immense and have been pushed back into the darkness of a divine mystery, something beyond the powers of imagination, so that finally the ancestor is necessarily transfigured into a god. Here perhaps lies even the origin of the gods, thus an origin out of fear! . . . And the man to whom it seems obligatory to add “But also out of piety” could hardly claim to be right for the longest period of the human race, for his *primaeval* age. Of course, he would be all the more correct for the middle period, in which the noble tribes developed—those who in fact paid back to their founders, their ancestors (heroes, gods), with interest, all the characteristics which in the meantime had become manifest in themselves, the noble qualities. Later we will have another look at the process by which the gods were ennobled and exalted (which is naturally not at all the same thing as their becoming “holy”). But now, for the moment, let’s follow the path of this whole development of the consciousness of guilt to its conclusion. 20 As history teaches us, the consciousness of being in debt to the gods did not in any way come to an end after the downfall of the organization of the “community” based on blood relationships. Just as humanity inherited the ideas of “good and bad” from the nobility of the tribe (together with its fundamental psychological tendency to set up orders of rank), in the same way people also inherited, as well as the divinities of the tribe and of the extended family, the pressure of as yet unpaid debts and the desire to be relieved of them. (The transition is made with those numerous slave and indentured populations which adapted themselves to the divine cults of their masters, whether through compulsion or through obsequiousness and mimicry; from them this inheritance then overflowed in all directions). The

feeling of being indebted to the gods did not stop growing for several thousands of years, always, in fact, in direct proportion to the extent to which the idea of god and the feeling for god grew on earth and were carried to the heights. (The entire history of ethnic fighting, victory, reconciliation, mergers, everything which comes before the final rank ordering of all the elements of a people in every great racial synthesis, is mirrored in the tangled genealogies of its gods, in the sagas of their fights, victories, and reconciliations. The progress towards universal empires is always also the progress toward universal divinities. In addition, despotism, with its overthrow of the independent nobility always builds the way to some variety of monotheism). The arrival of the Christian god, as the greatest [Maximal] god which has yet been reached, thus brought about the maximum feeling of indebtedness on earth. Assuming that we have gradually set out in the reverse direction, we can infer with no small probability that, given the inexorable decline of faith in the Christian god, even now there may already be a considerable decline in the human consciousness of guilt. Indeed, we cannot dismiss the idea that the complete and final victory of atheism could release humanity from this entire feeling of being indebted to its origin, its *causa prima* [prime cause]. Atheism and a kind of second innocence belong together.— 21 So much for a brief and rough preface concerning the connection between the ideas “guilt” and “obligation” with religious assumptions. Up to this point I have deliberately set aside the actual moralizing of these ideas (the repression of them into the conscience, or more precisely, the complex interaction of the bad conscience with the idea of god). At the end of the previous section I even talked as if there were no such thing as this moralizing and thus as if those ideas were now necessarily coming to an end after the collapse of their presuppositions, the faith in our “creditor,” in God. But to a terrifying extent the facts indicate something different. The moralizing of the ideas of debt and duty, with their repression into the bad conscience, actually gave rise to the attempt to reverse the direction of the development I have just described, or at least to bring its motion to a halt. Now, in a fit of pessimism, the prospect of a final installment must once and for all be denied; now, our gaze must bounce and ricochet back despairingly off an iron impossibility, now those ideas of “debt” and “duty” must turn back. But against whom? There can be no doubt: first of all against the “debtor,” in whom from this point on bad conscience sets itself firmly, gnaws away, spreads out, and, like a polyp, grows wide and deep to such an extent that finally, with the impossibility of discharging the debt, people also come up with the notion that it is impossible to remove the penance, the idea that it cannot be paid off (“eternal punishment”):—finally however, those ideas of “debt” and “duty” turn back even against the “creditor.” People should, in this matter, now think about the *causa prima* [first cause] of humanity, about the beginning of the human race, about their ancestor who from now on is loaded down with a curse (“Adam,”

“original sin,” “no freedom of the will”) or about nature from whose womb human beings arose and into which the principle of evil is now inserted (“the demonizing of nature”) or about existence in general, which remains something inherently without value (nihilistic turning away from existence, longing for nothingness, or a desire for its “opposite,” in an alternate state of being, Buddhism and things like that)—until all of a sudden we confront the paradoxical and horrifying expedient with which a martyred humanity found temporary relief, that stroke of genius of Christianity: God sacrificing himself for the guilt of human beings, God paying himself back with himself, God as the only one who can redeem man from what for human beings has become impossible to redeem—the creditor sacrificing himself for the debtor, out of love (can people believe that?), out of love for his debtor! . . . 22 You will already have guessed what really went on with all this and under all this: that will to self-torment, that repressed cruelty of animal man pushed inward and forced back into himself, imprisoned in the “state” to make him tame, who invented bad conscience in order to lacerate himself, after the more natural discharge of this will to inflict pain had been blocked—this man of bad conscience seized upon religious assumptions to drive his self-torment to its most horrifying hardship and ferocity. Guilt towards God: this idea becomes his instrument of torture. In “God” he seizes on the ultimate contrast he is capable of discovering to his real and indissoluble animal instincts. He interprets these animal instincts themselves as a crime against God (as enmity, rebellion, revolt against the “master,” the “father,” the original ancestor and beginning of the world). He grows tense with the contradiction of “God” and “devil.” He hurls from himself every “No” which he says to himself, to nature, naturalness, the factual reality [Tatsächlichkeit] of his being as a “Yes,” as something existing, as living, as real, as God, as the blessedness of God, as God the Judge, as God the Hangman, as something beyond him, as eternity, as perpetual torment, as hell, as punishment and guilt beyond measure. In this spiritual cruelty there is a kind of insanity of the will which simply has no equal: a man’s will finding him so guilty and reprehensible that there is no atonement, his will to imagine himself punished, but in such a way that the punishment could never be adequate for his crime, his will to infect and poison the most fundamental basis of things with the problem of punishment and guilt in order to cut himself off once and for all from any exit out of this labyrinth of “fixed ideas,” his will to erect an ideal—that of the “holy God”—in order to be tangibly certain of his own absolute worthlessness when confronted with it. O this insane, sad beast man! What ideas it has, what unnaturalness, what paroxysms of nonsense, what bestiality of thought breaks from it as soon as it is prevented, if only a little, from being a beast in deed! . . . All this is excessively interesting, but there’s also a black, gloomy, unnerving sadness about it, so that man must forcefully hold himself back from gazing too long into these abysses.

Here we have illness—no doubt about that—the most terrifying illness that has raged in human beings up to now:—and anyone who can still hear (but nowadays people no longer have the ear for that!—) how in this night of torment and insanity the cry of love has resounded, the cry of the most yearning delight, of redemption through love, turns away, seized by an invincible horror. . . In human beings there is so much that is terrible! . . . The world has already been a lunatic asylum for too long! 23 These remarks should be sufficient, once and for all, concerning the origin of the “holy God.”—The fact that conceiving gods does not necessarily, in itself, have to lead to this degraded imagination, that’s something we could not excuse ourselves from recalling for a moment, the point that there are more uplifting ways to use the invention of the gods than for this human self-crucifixion and self-laceration, in which Europe in the last millennia has become an expert—fortunately that’s something we can still infer with every glance we cast at the Greek gods, these reflections of nobler men, more rulers of themselves, in whom the animal in man felt himself deified and did not tear himself apart, did not rage against himself! These Greeks for the longest time used their gods for the very purpose of keeping that “bad conscience” at a distance, in order to be permitted to continue enjoying their psychic freedom. Hence, their understanding was the opposite of how Christianity used its God. In this matter the Greeks went a very long way, these splendid and lion-hearted Greeks, with their child-like minds. And no lesser authority than that of Homer’s Zeus himself now and then lets them understand that they are making things too easy for themselves. “It’s strange,” he says at one point in relation to the case of Aegisthus, a very bad case— It’s strange how these mortal creatures complain about the gods! Evil comes only from us, they claim, but they themselves Stupidly make themselves miserable, even contrary to fate.(8) But at the same time we hear and see that even this Olympian spectator and judge is far from being irritated and from thinking them evil because of this: “How foolish they are,” he thinks in relation to the bad deeds of mortal men—and even the Greeks of the strongest and bravest times conceded that much about themselves—the “foolishness,” “stupidity,” a little “disturbance in the head” were the basis for many bad and fateful things—foolishness, not sin! Do you understand that? . . . But even this disturbance in the head was a problem, “Indeed, how is this even possible? Where could this have really come from in heads like the ones we have, we men of noble descent, happy, successful, from the best society, noble, and virtuous?”—for hundreds of years the aristocratic Greek posed this question to himself in relation to every horror or outrage incomprehensible to him which had defiled one of his peers. “Some god must have deluded him,” he finally said, shaking his head . . . This solution is typical of the Greeks . . . In this way, the gods then served to justify men to a certain extent, even in bad things. They served as the origins of evil—at that time the gods took upon themselves, not

punishment, but, what is nobler, the guilt. . . 24 —I'll conclude with three question marks—that's clear enough. You may perhaps ask me, "Is an ideal actually being built up here or shattered?" . . . But have you ever really asked yourself enough how high a price has been paid on earth for the construction of every ideal? How much reality had to be constantly vilified and misunderstood for that to happen, how many lies had to be consecrated, how many consciences corrupted, how much "god" had to be sacrificed every time? In order to enable a shrine to be built, a shrine must be destroyed: that is the law—show me the case where it has not been fulfilled! We modern men, we are the inheritors of thousands of years of vivisection of the conscience and self-inflicted animal torture. That's what we have had the longest practice doing, that is perhaps our artistry; in any case, it's something we have refined, the corruption of our taste. For too long man has looked at his natural inclinations with an "evil eye," so that finally in him they have become twinned with "bad conscience." An attempt to reverse this might, in itself, be possible—but who is strong enough for it, that is, to link as siblings bad conscience and the unnatural inclinations, all those aspirations for what lies beyond, those things which go against our senses, against our instincts, against nature, against animals—in short, the earlier ideals, all the ideals which are hostile to life, ideals of those who vilify the world? To whom can we turn to today with such hopes and demands? . . . In this we would have precisely the good people against us, as well, of course, as the comfortable, the complacent, the vain, the enthusiastic, the tired. . . . But what is more deeply offensive, what cuts us off so fundamentally, as letting them take some note of the severity and loftiness with which we deal with ourselves? And, by contrast, how obliging, how friendly all the world is in relation to us, as soon as we act as all the world does and "let ourselves go" just like all the world! To attain the goal I'm talking about requires a different sort of spirit from those which are likely to exist at this particular time: spirits empowered by war and victory, for whom conquest, adventure, danger, and even pain have become a need. That would require getting acclimatized to keen, high air, winter wanderings, to ice and mountains in every sense. That would require even a kind of sublime maliciousness, an ultimate self-conscious wilfulness of knowledge, which comes with great health. Simply and seriously put, that would require just this great health! . . . Is this even possible today? . . . But at some time or other, in a more powerful time than this mouldy, self-doubting present, he must nonetheless come to us, the redeeming man of great love and contempt, the creative spirit, constantly pushed again and again away from every sideline or from the beyond by his own driving power, whose isolation is misunderstood by people as if it were a flight from reality—whereas it is only his immersion, burial, and absorption in reality, so that, once he comes out of it into the light again, he brings home the redemption of this reality, its redemption from the curse which

the previous ideal has laid upon it. This man of the future, who will release us from that earlier ideal just as much as from what had to grow from it, from the great loathing, from the will to nothingness, from nihilism—that stroke of noon and of the great decision which makes the will free once again, who gives back to the earth its purpose and to the human being his hope, this anti-Christ and anti-nihilist, this conqueror of God and of nothingness—at some point he must come . . . 25 But what am I talking about here? Enough, enough! At this stage there’s only one thing appropriate for me to do: keep quiet. Otherwise, I’ll make the mistake of arrogating to myself something which only someone younger is free to do, someone “more of the future,” someone more powerful than I am—something that only Zarathustra is free to do, Zarathustra the Godless . . . (9)

ENDNOTES (1) Nietzsche quotes the Latin: “si plus minusve secuerunt, ne fraude esto.” [Back to Text] (2) Spinoza: Baruch de Spinoza (1632-1677), important Dutch rationalist philosopher. [Back to Text] (3) Pope Innocent III: (1161-1216), an important and powerful medieval Pope. [Back to Text] (4) . . . ressentiment: As mentioned above (in the First Essay), Nietzsche uses this French word, which since his writing, and largely because of it, has entered the English language as an important term in psychology: a short definition is as follows: “deep-seated resentment, frustration, and hostility, accompanied by a sense of being powerless to express these feelings directly” (Merriam-Webster). Ressentiment is thus significantly different in meaning from resentment. [Back to Text] (5) E. Dühring: (1833-1921), German philosopher and economist. [Back to Text] (6) Herbert Spencer: (1820-1903), English philosopher who advanced the idea of evolution as a progressive process in society. Huxley: Thomas Huxley (1825-1895): a major English champion of Darwin’s evolutionary ideas. [Back to Text] (7) Heraclitus: (c. 535-475 BC) an important pre-Socratic Greek philosopher. [Back to Text] (8) Zeus makes these remarks to the other Olympian gods at the start of Homer’s *Odyssey*. Aegisthus seduced Clytaemnestra, and the two of them murdered Agamemnon, her husband, as soon as he returned home from the Trojan War. The gods, according to Homer, had warned him against these actions. [Back to Text] (9) Zarathustra: a name for the Persian prophet Zoroaster, which Nietzsche appropriates to designate a spokesman for his own ideas. [Back to Text] [Link to Genealogy of Morals](#), [Table of Contents Nietzsche](#), [Genealogy of Morals](#), [Third Essay Friedrich Nietzsche On the Genealogy of Morals A Polemical Tract Translated by Ian Johnston](#) Vancouver Island University Nanaimo, British Columbia 2014 [Students, teachers, artists, and members of the general public may download and distribute this text free of charge and without permission. They may also freely edit the text to suit their purposes. However, no commercial publication of this text or any part of it is allowed without permission of the translator. For any questions or comments please contact Ian Johnston. Note that in the following text, the words within

square brackets have been added by the translator. The numbers in curved brackets indicate links to explanatory endnotes provided by the translator.] If you would like to download a Rich Text Format (Word) text of this text, please use the following link: [Genealogy 3 \[RTF\] Third Essay What do ascetic ideals mean? Carefree, mocking, violent—that what Wisdom wants us to be. She is a woman. She always loves only a man of war. Thus Spoke Zarathustra\(1\)](#) 1 What do ascetic ideals mean?—Among artists they mean nothing or too many different things; among philosophers and scholars they mean something like having a nose or an instinct for the most auspicious conditions of a higher spirituality; among women, at best one additional seductive charm, a little morbidezza [small morbidity] on beautiful flesh, the angelic quality of a nice-looking, plump animal; among physiologically impaired and peevish people (that is, among the majority of mortals) they are an attempt to imagine themselves as “too good” for this world, a holy form of orgiastic excess, their chief tool in the fight with their enduring pain and boredom; among the clergy they are the essential priestly belief, their best instrument of power, and also the “highest of all” permits for power; finally among the saints they are a pretext for hibernation, their novissima glorie cupido [most recent desire for glory], their repose in nothingness (“God”), their form of insanity. However, the fact that generally the ascetic ideal has meant so much to human beings is an expression of the basic fact of the human will, its horror vacui [horror of a vacuum]. It requires a goal—and it prefers to will nothingness than not to will.—Do you understand me? . . . Have you understood me? . . . “Not in the slightest, my dear sir!”—so, let’s start from the beginning. 2 What do ascetic ideals mean?—Or, to take a single example which I have been asked to give advice about often enough, what does it mean, for instance, when an artist like Richard Wagner in his later years pays homage to chastity? In a certain sense, of course, he always did this, but in an ascetic sense he did it for the first time at the very end. What does this change in “sense” mean, this radical change in sense?—For that’s what it was: with it Wagner leapt right over into his opposite. What does it mean when an artist leaps over into his opposite? . . . If we are willing to pause for a while at this question, we immediately encounter here the memory of perhaps the best, strongest, most cheerful, and bravest period in Wagner’s life, the time when he was inwardly and deeply preoccupied with the idea of Luther’s marriage. Who knows the circumstances which really saw to it that today, instead of this wedding music, we have *Die Meistersinger*?(2) And how much of the former work may perhaps still echo in the latter? But there is no doubt that this “Luther’s Wedding” would also have involved the praise of chastity. Of course, it would have contained a praise of sensuality, as well—and that, it strikes me, would have been very much in order, very “Wagnerian,” too. For between chastity and sensuality there is no necessary opposition. Every good marriage, every genuine affair of the heart

transcends this opposition. In my view, Wagner would have done well if he had enabled his Germans to take this pleasant fact to heart once more, with the help of a lovely and brave comedy about Luther, for among the Germans there are and always have been a lot of people who slander sensuality, and Luther's merit is probably nowhere greater than precisely here: in having had the courage of his own sensuality (—at that time people called it, delicately enough, “evangelical freedom”). But even if it were the case that there really is that antithesis between chastity and sensuousness, fortunately there is no need for it to be a tragic antithesis. At least this should be the case for all successful and cheerful mortals, who are far from considering their unstable equilibrium between “animal and angel” an immediate argument against existence—the finest and brightest, like Goethe, like Hafiz, even saw in this one more attraction of life. It's precisely such “contradictions” that make existence enticing. . . . On the other hand, it's easy enough to understand that once pigs who have had bad luck are persuaded to worship chastity—and there are such swine!—they see in chastity only their opposite, the opposite to unlucky pigs, and will worship that—and with such zealous tragic grunting! We can imagine it—that embarrassing and unnecessary antithesis, which Richard Wagner at the end of his life unquestioningly still wanted to set to music and produce on stage. But what for? That's a fair question. For why should he be concerned about pigs? Why should we?— 3 In this matter there is, of course, another question we cannot circumvent: why was Wagner really concerned about that manly (alas, so unmanly) “simpleton from the country,” that poor devil and nature boy Parsifal, whom he finally turned into a Catholic in such an embarrassing way.(3) What? Was this Parsifal meant to be taken at all seriously? For we could be tempted to assume the reverse, even to desire it—that the Wagnerian Parsifal was intended to be cheerful, a concluding piece and satyr drama, as it were, with which the tragic writer Wagner wanted to take his farewell, in a respectful manner worthy of him, from us, also from himself, and, above all, from tragedy, that is, with an excess of the highest and most high-spirited parody of the tragic itself, of the entire dreadful earthly seriousness and earthly wailing of his earlier works, of the crudest form in the anti-nature of the ascetic ideal, conquered at last. That would have been, as mentioned, particularly worthy of a great tragedian, who, like every artist, first attains the final peak of his greatness when he knows how to see himself and his art beneath him—when he knows how to laugh at himself. Is Parsifal Wagner's secret superior laughter at himself, the triumph of his achieving the ultimate and highest artistic freedom, the artist's movement into another world [Künstler-Jenseitigkeit]? As I've said, we might wish that. For what would Parsifal be if intended seriously? Do we need to see in it (as it was put to me) “the epitome of an insane hatred for knowledge, spirit, and sensuality”? A curse on the senses and the spirit in one breath of hatred? An apostasy and going back to sickly Christian

and obscurantist ideals? And finally even a denial of the self, a cancellation of the self on the part of an artist who up to that point had directed all the power of his will to attain the reverse, namely, the highest spiritualization and sensuousness in his art? And not only in his art, but also in his life. We should remember how Wagner in his day so enthusiastically followed in the footsteps of the philosopher Feuerbach. Feuerbach's phrase about "healthy sensuality"—in Wagner's thirties and forties, as with many Germans (—they called themselves the "young Germans"), that phrase rang out like a word of redemption. Did Wagner finally learn something different? It appears, at least, that he finally wanted to teach something different. And not only on the stage with the Parsifal trombones:—in the cloudy writings of his last years—as constricted as they are baffling—there are a hundred places which betray a secret wish and will, a despondent, uncertain, unacknowledged will essentially to preach nothing but going back, conversion, denial, Christianity, medievalism, and to say to his followers "It's nothing! Seek salvation somewhere else!" In one place he even calls out to the "Blood of the Redeemer" . . . 4 In a case like Wagner's, which is in many ways an embarrassing one, although the example is typical, my opinion is that it's certainly best to separate an artist far enough from his work, so that one does not take him with the same seriousness as one does his work. In the final analysis, he is only the precondition for his work, its maternal womb, the soil or, in some cases, the dung and manure, on and out of which it grows—and thus, in most cases, something that we must forget about, if we want to enjoy the work itself. Insight into the origin of a work is a matter for physiologists and vivisectionists of the spirit, never the aesthetic men, the artists—never! In a deep, fundamental, even terrifying way the poet and composer of Parsifal could not escape living inside and descending into the conflicts of the medieval soul, a hostile distance from all spiritual loftiness, rigour, and discipline, a form of intellectual perversity (if you will forgive the expression), any more than a pregnant woman can escape the repellent and strange aspects of pregnancy, something which, as I have said, one must forget if one wants to enjoy the child. We should be on our guard against that confusion which arises from psychological contiguity (to use an English word), a confusion in which even an artist can only too easily get caught up, as if he himself were what he can present, imagine, and express. In fact, the case is this: if that were what he was, he simply would not present, imagine, or express it. A Homer would not have written a poem about Achilles or a Goethe a poem about Faust if Homer had been an Achilles or if Goethe had been a Faust. A complete and entire artist is forever separated from the "real," from what actually is. On the other hand, one can understand how he can sometimes grow weary of this eternal "unreality" and falseness of his innermost existence to the point of desperation—and that he then makes an attempt for once to reach over into what is forbidden precisely to him,

into reality, in an attempt truly to be. What success does he have? We can guess . . . That is the typical wishfulness of the artist: the same wishfulness which fell over Wagner once he'd grown old and for which he had to pay such a high, fatal price (—because of it he lost a valuable number of his friends). Finally, however, and quite apart from this mere wishfulness of his, who could not desire—for Wagner's own sake—that he had taken his leave of us and his art in a different manner, not with a Parsifal, but more victoriously, more self-confidently, more like Wagner—less deceptive, less ambiguous about all his intentions, less like Schopenhauer, less nihilistic? 5 —So what do ascetic ideals mean? In the case of an artist, we know the answer immediately:—absolutely nothing! . . . Or they mean so many things, that they amount to nothing at all! . . . So let's eliminate the artists right away. They do not stand independent of the world and against the world long enough for their evaluations and the changes in those evaluations to merit our interest for their own sake! They have in all ages been valets to a morality or philosophy or religion, quite apart from the fact that, often enough, they unfortunately have been the all-too-adaptable courtiers of groups of their followers and their patrons and flatterers with a fine nose for old or simply newly arriving powers. At the very least, they always need a means of protection, a support, an already established authority. The artists never stand for themselves—standing alone contravenes their deepest instincts. Hence, for example, “once the time had come” Richard Wagner took the philosopher Schopenhauer as his point man, as his protection. Who could have even imagined that he would have had the courage for an ascetic ideal without the support which Schopenhauer's philosophy offered him, without the authority of Schopenhauer, which was becoming predominant in Europe in the 1870's? (And that's not even considering whether in the new Germany it would have been generally possible to be an artist without the milk of a pious, imperially pious way of thinking).(4)—And with this we come to the more serious question: What does it mean when real philosopher pays homage to the ascetic ideal, a truly independent spirit like Schopenhauer, a man and a knight with an bronze gaze, who is courageous to himself, who knows how to stand alone and does not first wait for a front man and hints from higher up?—Here let us consider right away the remarkable and for many sorts of people even fascinating position of Schopenhauer on art, for that was apparently the reason Richard Wagner first moved over to Schopenhauer (persuaded to do that, as we know, by a poet, by Herwegh). That shift was so great that it opened up a complete theoretical contrast between his earlier and his later aesthetic beliefs— between, for example, the earlier views expressed in “Opera and Drama” and the later views in the writings which he published from 1870 on. In particular, what is perhaps most surprising is that from this point on Wagner ruthlessly altered his judgment of the value and place of music itself. Why should it concern him that up to that

point he had used music as a means, a medium, a “woman,” something which simply required a purpose, a man, in order to flourish—that is, drama! Suddenly he realized that with Schopenhauer’s theory and innovation he could do more in *majo rem musicae gloriam* [for the greater glory of music]—that is, through the sovereignty of music, as Schopenhauer understood it: music set apart from all other arts, the inherently independent art, not, like the other arts, offering copies of phenomena, but rather the voice of the will itself speaking out directly from the “abyss” as its most authentic, most primordial, least derivative revelation. With this extraordinary increase in the value of music, as this seemed to grow out of Schopenhauer’s philosophy, the musician himself also suddenly grew in value to an unheard of extent: from now on he would be an oracle, a priest, more than a priest, in fact, a kind of mouthpiece of the “essence” of things, a telephone from the world beyond—in future he didn’t speak only of music, this ventriloquist of God—he talked metaphysics. Is it any wonder that finally one day he spoke about ascetic ideals? . . . 6

Schopenhauer used Kant’s formulation of the aesthetic problem— although he certainly did not examine it with Kantian eyes. Kant thought he had honoured art when among the predicates of the beautiful he gave priority to and set in the foreground those which constitute the honour of knowledge—impersonality and universal validity. Here is not the place to explore whether or not this is for the most part a false idea. The only thing I wish to stress is that Kant, like all philosophers, instead of taking aim at the aesthetic problem from the experiences of the artist (the creator), thought about art and the beautiful only from the point of view of the “looker on” and in the process, without anyone noticing it, brought the “spectator” himself into the concept “beautiful.” If only these philosophers of beauty had also been at least sufficiently knowledgeable about this “spectator”!— that is, as a great personal fact and experience, as a wealth of very particular, strong experiences, desires, surprises, and delights in the realm of the beautiful! But I fear the opposite has always been the case. And so from the very start we get from them definitions like that famous one which Kant gives for the beautiful, in which the lack of a finer self-experience sits in the shape of a thick worm of fundamental error. “The beautiful,” Kant said, “is what pleases in a disinterested way.” In a disinterested way! Let’s compare this definition with that other one formulated by a true “spectator” and artist—Stendhal, who once called the beautiful a *promesse de bonheur* [a promise of happiness]. Here, at any rate, the very thing which Kant emphasises in the aesthetic state is clearly rejected and deleted: *déintéressement* [disinterestedness]. Who is right, Kant or Stendhal?(5)—Naturally, if our aestheticians never get tired of weighing the issue in Kant’s favour, claiming that under the magic spell of beauty people can look even at unclothed female statues “without interest,” we are entitled to laugh a little at their expense:—in relation to this delicate matter, the experiences of artists are “more interesting,” and

Pygmalion was in any event not necessarily an “unaesthetic man.”(6) Let’s think all the better of the innocence of our aestheticians, which is reflected in such arguments. For example, let’s count it to Kant’s honour that he knew how to lecture on the characteristic properties of the sense of touch with the naïveté of a country parson.—This point brings us back to Schopenhauer, who stood measurably closer to the arts than Kant but who nonetheless did not get away from the spell of the Kantian definition. How did that happen? The circumstance is sufficiently odd. He interpreted the word “disinterested” in the most personal manner from a single experience which must have been something routine with him. There are few things Schopenhauer talks about with as much confidence as he does about the effect of aesthetic contemplation. In connection with that, he states that it counteracts sexual “interest” in particular—and thus acts like lupulin or camphor. He never got tired of extolling this emancipation from the “will” as the great advantage and use of the aesthetic state. Indeed, we could be tempted to ask whether his basic conception of “Will and Idea,” the notion that there could be a redemption from the “will” only through “representation,” might have taken its origin from a universalizing of that sexual experience. (With all questions concerning Schopenhauer’s philosophy, incidentally, we should never fail to consider that it is the conception of a twenty-six-year-old young man, so that it involves not merely the specific details of Schopenhauer but also the particular details of that time of life). If, for example, we listen to one of the most expressive passages from the countless ones he wrote to honour the aesthetic state (*World as Will and Idea*, I, 231), we hear its tone, the suffering, the happiness, the gratitude uttered in words like these: “That is the painless condition which Epicurus valued as the highest good and as the condition of the gods. For that moment, we are relieved of the contemptible drive of the will. We celebrate a holiday[den Sabbat] from the penal servitude to the will. The wheel of Ixion stands motionless.”(7) . . . What vehemence in the words! What a picture of torment and long weariness! What an almost pathological temporal contrast between “that moment” and the usual “wheel of Ixion,” the “penal servitude to the will,” the “contemptible drive of the will”!—But assuming that Schopenhauer were right a hundred times about himself, what would that provide by way of insight into the essence of the beautiful? Schopenhauer wrote about one effect of the beautiful—the way it calms the will—but is it a regularly occurring effect? Stendhal, as mentioned, a no less sensual person, but with a natural constitution much happier than Schopenhauer’s, emphasizes another effect of the beautiful: “the beautiful promises happiness.” To him the fact of the matter seemed to be precisely the arousal of the will (“of interest”) by the beautiful. And could we not finally object about Schopenhauer himself that he was very wrong to think of himself as a Kantian in this matter, that he had completely failed to understand Kant’s definition of the beautiful in a Kantian

manner—that even he found the beautiful pleasing out of an “interest,” even out of the strongest and most personal interest of all, that of a torture victim who escapes from his torture? . . . And to come back to our first question, “What does it mean when a philosopher renders homage to the ascetic ideal?”—we get here at least our first hint: he wants to escape a torture. 7 Let’s be careful not to make gloomy faces right away at that word “torture.” In this particular case there remain enough objections to take into account, enough to subtract—there even remains something to laugh about. For let’s not underestimate the fact that Schopenhauer, who in fact treated sexuality as a personal enemy (including its instrument, woman, this “instrumentum diaboli” [tool of the devil]), needed enemies in order to maintain his good spirits, that he loved grim, caustic, black-green words, that he got angry for the sake of getting passionately angry, that he would have become ill, would have become a pessimist (—and he wasn’t a pessimist, no matter how much he wanted to be one) without his enemies, without Hegel, woman, sensuousness, and the whole will for existence, for continuing on. Had that not been the case, Schopenhauer would not have kept going—on that we can wager. He would have run off. But his enemies held him securely; his enemies seduced him back to existence again and again. Just like the ancient cynics, his anger was his refreshment, his relaxation, his payment, his remedy for disgust, his happiness. So much with respect to the most personal features in the case of Schopenhauer. On the other hand, with him there is still something typical—and here we only come up against our problem once more. As long as there have been philosophers on earth and wherever there have been philosophers (from India to England, to name two opposite poles of talent in philosophy) there unquestionably have existed a genuine philosophical irritability with and rancor against sensuousness—Schopenhauer is only the most eloquent eruption of these and, if one has an ear for it, also the most captivating and delightful. In addition, there exist a real philosophical bias and affection favouring the whole ascetic ideal. No one should fool himself about or against that. As mentioned, both belong to the philosophical type: if both are missing in a philosopher then he is always only a “so-called philosopher”—of that we may be certain. What does that mean? For we must first interpret these facts of the case: in itself stands there eternally stupid, like every “thing in itself.” Every animal, including also la bête philosophe [the philosophical animal] instinctively strives for the optimal beneficial conditions in which it can let out all its power and attain the strongest feeling of its strength. Every animal in an equally instinctual way and with a refined sense of smell that “is loftier than all reason” abhors any kind of trouble maker and barrier which lies or which could lie in its way to these optimal conditions (—I’m not speaking about its path to “happiness,” but about its way to power, to action, to its most powerful deeds, and, in most cases, really about its way to unhappiness). Thus, the philosopher abhors marriage, as well as

what might persuade him into it—marriage is a barrier and a disaster along his route to the optimal. What great philosopher up to now has been married? Heraclitus, Plato, Descartes, Spinoza, Leibnitz, Kant, Schopenhauer—none of these got married. What’s more, we cannot even imagine them married. A married philosopher belongs in a comedy, that’s my principle. And Socrates, that exception, the malicious Socrates, it appears, ironically got married specifically to demonstrate this very principle. Every philosopher would speak as once Buddha spoke when someone told him of the birth of a son, “Rahula has been born to me. A shackle has been forged for me.” (Rahula here means “a little demon”). To every “free spirit” there must come a reflective hour, provided that previously he has had one without thought, of the sort that once came to this same Buddha—“Life in a house,” he thought to himself, “is narrow and confined, a polluted place. Freedom consists of abandoning the house”; “because he thought this way, he left the house.” The ascetic ideal indicates so many bridges to independence that a philosopher cannot, without an inner rejoicing and applause, listen to the history of all those decisive people who one day said “No” to all lack of freedom and went off to some desert or other, even assuming that such people were merely strong donkeys and entirely opposite to a powerful spirit. So what, then, does the ascetic ideal mean as far as a philosopher is concerned? My answer is—you will have guessed it long ago—the philosopher smiles when he sees in it an optimal set of conditions for the loftiest and boldest spirituality—in so doing, he does not deny “existence”; rather that’s how he affirms his existence and only his existence and does this perhaps to such a degree that he is not far from the wicked desire *pereat mundus, fiat philosophia, fiat philosophus, fiam!* [let the world perish, let philosophy exist, let the philosopher exist, let me exist!] . . . (8) 8 You see that these philosophers are not unprejudiced witnesses to and judges of the value of ascetic ideals! They think about themselves—what concern to them is “the saint”! In this matter they think about what is most immediately indispensable to them: freedom from compulsion, disturbance, fuss, from business, duties, worries: a bright light in the head, dance, the leap and flight of ideas; good air—thin, clear, free, dry—like the air at high altitudes, with which everything in animal being grows more spiritual and acquires wings; calm in all basement areas; all dogs nicely tied up in chains; no hostile barking and shaggy rancour; no gnawing worm of wounded ambition; modest and humble inner organs busy as windmills but at a distance; the heart in an alien place, beyond, in the future, posthumous—all in all, so far as the ascetic ideal is concerned, they think of the cheerful asceticism of some deified animal which has become independent, roaming above life rather than being at rest. We know what the three great catch phrases of the ascetic ideal are: poverty, humility, chastity. Now look closely at the lives of all great, prolific, inventive spirits—over and over again you’ll rediscover all three there to a certain degree.

Not at all—this is self-evident—as if it were something to do with their “virtues”—what does this kind of man have to do with virtues?—but as the truest and most natural conditions of their best existence, their most beautiful fecundity. At the same time, it is indeed entirely possible that their dominating spirituality at first had to set aside an unbridled and sensitive pride or the reins of a wanton sensuality or that they perhaps had difficulty enough maintaining their will for the “desert” against an inclination for luxury, for something very exquisite, as well as against a lavish liberality of heart and hand. But their spirituality did it, simply because it was the dominating instinct, which achieves its own demands in relation to all the other instincts—it still continues to do so. If it did not, then it would simply not dominate. Hence, this has nothing to do with “virtue.” Besides, the desert I just mentioned, into which the strong spirits with an independent nature withdraw and isolate themselves—O how different it seems from the desert educated people dream about!—for in some circumstances these educated people are themselves this desert. And certainly no actor of the spirit could simply endure it—for them it is not nearly romantic and Syrian enough, not nearly enough of a theatrical desert! It’s true there’s no lack of camels there, but that’s the only similarity between them. Perhaps a voluntary obscurity, a detour away from one’s self, a timidity about noise, admiration, newspapers, influence; a small official position, a daily routine, something which hides more than it brings to light, contact now and then with harmless, cheerful wildlife and birds whose sight is relaxing, a mountain for company, not a dead one but one with eyes (that means with lakes); in some circumstances even a room in a full, nondescript inn, where one is sure to be confused for someone else and can talk to anyone with impunity—that’s what a “desert” is here. O, it’s lonely enough, believe me! When Heraclitus withdrew into the courtyard and colonnades of the immense temple of Artemis, that was a worthier “desert,” I admit. Why do we lack such temples? (—Perhaps we do not lack them. I’ve just remembered my most beautiful room for study, the Piazza San Marco, assuming it’s in the spring, and in the morning, too, between ten and twelve o’clock).⁽⁹⁾ But what Heraclitus was getting away from is still the same thing we go out of our way to escape nowadays: the noise and the democratic chatter of the Ephesians, their politics, their news about the “empire” (you understand I mean the Persians), their market junk of “today”—for we philosophers need peace and quiet from one thing above all— from everything to do with “today.” We honour what is still, cold, noble, distant, past, in general everything at the sight of which the soul does not have to defend itself or tie itself up—something with which a person can speak without having to speak aloud. People should just listen to the sound which a spirit has when it is talking. Every spirit has its own sound, loves its own sound. The man over there, for example, must be a real agitator, I mean a hollow head, a hollow pot [Hohlkopf, Hohltopf]); no matter what goes into him, everything

comes back out of him dull and thick, weighed down with the echo of a huge emptiness. That man over there rarely speaks in anything other than a hoarse voice. Has he perhaps imagined himself hoarse? That might be possible—ask the physiologists—but whoever thinks in words thinks as a speaker and not as a thinker (it reveals that fundamentally he does not think of things or think factually, but only in relation to things, that he really is thinking of himself and his listeners). A third man over there speaks with an insistent familiarity, he steps in too close to our bodies, he breathes over us—instinctively we shut our mouths, even though he is speaking to us through a book. The sound of his style tells us the reason for that—he has no time, he has little faith in himself, he'll have his say today or never again. But a spirit which is sure of itself, speaks quietly. He's looking for seclusion. He lets people wait for him. We recognize a philosopher by the following: he walks away from three glittering and garish things—fame, princes, and women. That doesn't mean that they might not come to him. He shrinks from light which is too bright. Hence, he shies away from his time and its "day." In that he's like a shadow: the lower the sun sinks, the bigger he becomes. So far as his "humility" is concerned, he endures a certain dependence and obscurity, as he endures the darkness. More than that, he fears being disturbed by lightning and recoils from the unprotected and totally isolated and abandoned tree on which all bad weather can discharge its mood, all moods discharge their bad weather. His "maternal" instinct, the secret love for what is growing in him, directs him to places where his need to think of himself is removed, in the same sense that the maternal instinct in women has up to now generally kept her in a dependent situation. Ultimately they demand little enough, these philosophers. Their motto is "Whoever owns things is owned"—not, as I must say again and again, from virtue, from an admirable desire for modest living and simplicity, but because their highest master demands that of them, demands astutely and unrelentingly. He cares for only one thing and for that gathers up and holds everything—time, power, love, interest. This sort of man doesn't like to be disturbed by hostile things and by friendships; he easily forgets or scoffs. To him martyrdom seems something in bad taste—"to suffer for the truth"—he leaves that to the ambitious and the stage heroes of the spirit and anyone else who has time enough for it (—they themselves, the philosophers, have something to (do for the truth). They use big words sparingly. It's said that they resist using even the word "truth": it sounds boastful. . . . Finally, as far as "chastity" concerns philosophers, this sort of spirit apparently keeps its fertility in something other than in children; perhaps they also keep the continuity of their names elsewhere, their small immortality (among philosophers in ancient India people spoke with even more presumption, "What's the point of offspring to the man whose soul is the world?"). There's no sense of chastity there out of some ascetic scruple and hatred of the senses, just as it has little to do with chastity when an athlete or

jockey abstains from women. It's more a matter of what their dominating instinct wants, at least during its great pregnant periods. Every artist knows how damaging the effects of sexual intercourse are to states of great spiritual tension and preparation. The most powerful and most instinctual artists among them don't acquire this knowledge primarily by experience, by bad experience—no, it's simply that “maternal” instinct of theirs which here makes the decision ruthlessly to benefit the developing work among all the other stores and supplies of energy, of animal vitality. The greater power then uses up the lesser. Incidentally, apply this interpretation now to the above-mentioned case of Schopenhauer: the sight of the beautiful evidently worked in him as the stimulus for the main power in his nature (the power of reflection and the deep look), so that this then exploded and suddenly became master of his consciousness. In the process, we should in no way rule out the possibility that that characteristic sweetness and abundance typical of the aesthetic condition could originate precisely from the ingredient “sensuality” (just as from the same source is derived that “idealism” characteristic of sexually mature young girls)—so that thus, with the onset of the aesthetic condition, sensuality is not shoved out, as Schopenhauer believed, but is transformed and does not enter the consciousness any more as sexual stimulation. (I will come back to this point of view at another time, in connection with the even more delicate problems of the physiology of aesthetics, so untouched up to this point, so unanalyzed). 9 A certain asceticism, as we have seen, a hard and cheerful renunciation with the best intentions, belongs to those conditions favourable to the highest spirituality and is also among its most natural consequences. So it's no wonder from the outset that philosophers in particular never treat the ascetic ideal without some bias. A serious historical review demonstrates that the tie between the ascetic ideal and philosophy is even much closer and stronger. We could say it was in the leading reins of this ideal that philosophy in general learned to take its first steps and partial steps on earth—alas, still so awkwardly, alas, still with such a morose expression, alas, so ready to fall over and lie on its belly, this small, tentative, clumsy, loving infant with crooked legs! With philosophy things initially played themselves out as with all good things: for a long time it had no courage for itself—it always looked around to see if anyone would come to its assistance, and even more it was afraid of all those who gazed at it. Just make a list of the individual drives and virtues of the philosopher—his impulse to doubt, his impulse to deny, his impulse to wait (the “ephectic” impulse), his impulse to analyze, his impulse to research, to seek out, to take chances, his impulse to compare, to weigh evenly, his desire for neutrality and objectivity, his will to every “sine ira et studio” [without anger and partiality]—have we not already understood that for the longest time all of them went against the first demands of morality and conscience (to say nothing at all about reason in general, which

even Luther liked to call Madam Clever, the Clever Whore) and that if a philosopher were to have come to an awareness of himself, he would really have had to feel that he was almost the living manifestation of “*nitimur invetum*” [we search for what’s forbidden]—and thus taken care not to “feel himself,” not to become conscious of himself? As I’ve said, the case is no different with all the good things of which we are nowadays so proud. Even measured by the standards of the ancient Greeks, our entire modern being, insofar as it is not weakness but power and consciousness of power, looks like sheer hubris and godlessness; for the very opposite of those things we honour today have for the longest period had conscience on their side and God to guard over them. Our entire attitude to nature today, our violation of nature, with the help of machines and the unimaginable inventiveness of our technicians and engineers, is hubris; our attitude to God is hubris—I mean our attitude to some alleged spider spinning out purposes and morality behind the fabric of the huge fishing net of causality—we could say with Charles the Bold in his struggle with Ludwig XI, “*Je combats l’universelle araignée*” [I am fighting the universal spider]; our attitude to ourselves is hubris—for we experiment with ourselves in a manner we would not permit with any animal and happily and inquisitively slit the souls of living bodies open. What do we still care about the “salvation” of the soul? We cure ourselves later. Being sick teaches us things—we don’t doubt that—it’s even more instructive than being healthy. The person who makes us ill appears to us nowadays to be more important even than any medical people and “saviours.” We violate ourselves now, no doubt about it, we nutcrackers of the soul, we questioning and questionable people, as if life were nothing else but cracking nuts. And in so doing, we must necessarily become every day constantly more questionable, more worthy of being questioned, and in the process perhaps also worthier—to live? All good things were once bad things; every original sin has become an original virtue. For example, marriage for a long time seemed to be a sin against the rights of the community. Once people paid a fine for being so presumptuous as to arrogate a woman to themselves (that involves, for instance, the *jus primae noctis* [the right of the first night], even today in Cambodia the privilege of the priest, this guardian of “good ancient customs”). The gentle, favourable, yielding, sympathetic feelings—which over time grew so valuable that they are almost “value in itself”—for the longest period were countered by self-contempt against them. People were ashamed of being mild, just as today they are ashamed of being hard (compare *Beyond Good and Evil*, Section 260). Subjugation under the law—O with what resistance of conscience the noble races throughout the earth had to renounce the vendetta and to concede the power of the law over themselves! For a long time the “law” was a *vetum* [something prohibited], a sacrilege, an innovation; it appeared with force, as force, something to which people submitted only with a feeling of shame for their

conduct. Every one of the smallest steps on earth in earlier days was fought for with spiritual and physical torture. This whole historical point, “that not only moving forward—no!—but walking, moving, and changing necessarily required their countless martyrs,” nowadays sounds so strange to us. In *The Dawn*, Section 18, I brought out this point. “Nothing has come at a higher price,” it says there, “than the small amount of human reason and feeling of freedom, which we are now so proud of. But because of this pride it is now almost impossible for us to sense how that huge stretch of time of the ‘morality of custom,’ which comes before ‘world history,’ is the really decisive and important history which established the character of humanity, when everywhere people recognized suffering as virtue, cruelty as virtue, pretence as virtue, revenge as virtue, the denial of reason as virtue and, by contrast, well-being as danger, the desire for knowledge as danger, peace as danger, pity as danger, being pitied as disgrace, work as disgrace, insanity as divinity, change as inherently immoral and pregnant with ruin!”¹⁰ The same book, in Section 42, explains the system of values, the pressure of a system of values, under which the most ancient race of contemplative men had to live—a race that was despised exactly to the extent that it was not feared! Contemplation first appeared on earth in a disguised shape, with an ambiguous appearance, with an evil heart, and often with a worried head. There’s no doubt about that. For a long time the inactive, brooding, unwarlike elements in the instincts of contemplative people fostered a deep mistrust around them, against which the only way to cope was to arouse an emphatic fear of them. The ancient Brahmins, for example, understood that! The oldest philosophers knew how to earn meaning for their existence and their appearance, some security and background, because of which people learned to fear them. To look at the matter more closely, this happened because of an even more fundamental need, that is, the need to win fear and respect for themselves. For they discovered that inside them all judgments of value had turned against them; they had to beat down all kinds of suspicions about and resistance to “the philosopher inside them.” As men of dreadful times, they achieved this with dreadful means: cruelty against themselves, inventive self-denial—that was the major instrument of these power-hungry hermits and new thinkers, who found it necessary first to overthrow the gods and traditions inside themselves, in order to be able to believe in their innovation. I recall the famous story of King Vishvamitra, who, through a thousand years of self-torments, acquired such a feeling of power and faith in himself that he committed himself to building a new heaven, that weird symbol of the oldest and most recent history of philosophers on earth. Everyone who at some time or another has built a “new heaven,” found the power to do that first in his own hell. . . . Let’s condense all these facts into short formulas: the philosophical spirit always had to begin by disguising itself, wrapping itself in a cocoon of the previously established forms of the

contemplative man, as priest, magician, prophet, generally as a religious man, in order to make any kind of life at all possible. The ascetic ideal for a long time served the philosopher as a form in which he could appear, as a condition for his existence—he had to play the role, in order to be able to be a philosopher. And he had to believe in what he was doing, in order to play that role. The characteristically detached stance of philosophers, something which denies the world, is hostile to life, has no faith in the senses, and is free of sensuality, which was maintained right up to the most recent times and thus became valued almost as the essence of the philosophical posture—that is, above all, a consequence of the critical conditions under which, in general, philosophy arose and survived. In fact, for the longest time on earth philosophy would not have been at all possible without an ascetic cover and costume, without an ascetic misunderstanding of the self. To put the matter explicitly and vividly: up to the most recent times the ascetic priest has provided the repellent and dark caterpillar form which was the only one in which philosophy could live and creep around. . . . Has that really changed? Is the colourful and dangerous winged creature, that “spirit” which this caterpillar hid within itself, at last really been released and allowed out into the light, thanks to a sunnier, warmer, brighter world? Nowadays do we have sufficient pride, daring, bravery, self-certainty, spiritual will, desire to assume responsibility, and freedom of the will so that from now on “the philosopher” is truly possible on earth? . . . 11 Only now that we have taken a look at the ascetic priest can we seriously get at our problem: What does the ascetic ideal mean—only now does it become “serious.” From this point on we confront the actual representative of seriousness. “What does all seriousness mean?”—this even more fundamental question perhaps lies already on our lips, a question for physiologists, naturally, but nonetheless one which we will still evade for the moment. In that ideal, the ascetic priest preserves, not merely his faith, but also his will, his power, his interest. His right to existence stands and falls with that ideal. No wonder that here we run into a fearful opponent, given, of course, that we were people antagonistic to that ideal?—an opponent of the sort who fights for his existence against those who deny the ideal. . . . On the other hand, it is from the outset improbable that such an interesting stance to our problem will be particularly beneficial to it. The ascetic priest will hardly in himself prove the most successful defender of his ideal, for the same reason that a woman habitually fails when it’s a matter of defending “woman as such”—to say nothing of his being able to provide the most objective assessment of and judgment about the controversy we are dealing with here. Rather than having to fear that he will refute us too well—this much is clear enough—it’s more likely we’ll still have to help him defend himself against us. . . . The idea being contested at this point is the value of our lives in the eyes of ascetic priests: this same life (along with what belongs to it, “nature,” “the world,” the whole sphere of becoming and

transience) they set up in relation to an existence of a totally different kind, a relationship characterized by opposition and mutual exclusion, except where life somehow turns against itself, denies itself. In this case, the case of an ascetic life, living counts as a bridge over to that other existence. The ascetic treats life as an incorrect road, where we must finally go backwards, right to the place where it begins, or as a misconception which man refutes by his actions—or should refute. For he demands that people go with him. Where he can, he enforces his evaluation of existence. What's the meaning of that? Such a monstrous way of assessing value does not stand inscribed in human history as something exceptional and curious. It is one of the most widespread and enduring extant facts. If read from a distant star, the block capital script of our earthly existence might perhaps lead one to conclude that the earth is the inherently ascetic star, a corner for discontented, arrogant, and repellent creatures, incapable of ridding themselves of a deep dissatisfaction with themselves, with the earth, with all living, creatures who inflict as much harm on themselves as possible for the pleasure of inflicting harm—probably their single pleasure. We should consider how regularly, how commonly, how in almost all ages the ascetic priest makes an appearance. He does not belong to one single race. He flourishes everywhere. He grows from all levels of society. And it's not the case that he breeds and replants his way of assessing value somehow through biological inheritance: the opposite the case—generally speaking, a deep instinct forbids him from reproducing. There must be a high-order necessity which makes this species hostile to life always grow again and flourish—it must be in the interest of life itself not to have such a type of self-contradiction die out. For an ascetic life is a self-contradiction. Here a resentment without equal is in control, something with an insatiable instinct and will to power, which wants to become master, not over something in life but over life itself, over its deepest, strongest, most basic conditions; here an attempt is being made to use one's power to block up the sources of that power; here one directs one's green and malicious gaze against one's inherent physiological health, particularly against its means of expression—beauty, joy—while one experiences and seeks for a feeling of pleasure in mistrust, atrophy, pain, accident, ugliness, voluntary loss, self-denial, self-flagellation, self-sacrifice.⁽¹⁰⁾ All this is paradoxical to the highest degree. Here we stand in front of a dichotomy which essentially wants a dichotomy, which enjoys itself in this suffering and always gets even more self-aware and more triumphant in proportion to the decrease in its own prerequisite, the physiological capacity for life. “Triumph precisely in the ultimate agony”—under this supreme sign the ascetic ideal has fought from time immemorial. Inside this riddle of seduction, in this picture of delight and torment, it sees its highest light, its salvation, its final victory. Crux, nux, lux [cross, nut, light]—for the ascetic ideal these are all one thing. 12 Given that such a living desire for contradiction and

hostility to nature is used to practise philosophy, on what will it discharge its most inner arbitrary power? It will do that on something it perceives, with the greatest certainty, as true, as real. It will seek out error precisely where the essential instinct for life has established its most unconditional truth. For example, it will demote physical life to an illusion, as the ascetics of the Vedanta philosophy did. Similarly it will treat pain, the multiplicity of things, the whole ideational opposition between “subject” and “object” as error, nothing but error! To deny faith in one’s own self, to deny one’s own “reality”—what a triumph!—and not just over the senses, over appearances, but a much loftier kind of triumph, an overpowering of and act of cruelty against reason: a process in which the highest peak of delight occurs when ascetic self-contempt and self-mockery of reason proclaims: “There is a kingdom of truth and being, but reason is expressly excluded from it” . . . (By the way, even in the Kantian idea of the “intelligible character of things” there still remains something of this lecherous ascetic dichotomy, which loves to turn reason against reason: for the “intelligible character” with Kant means a sort of composition of things about which the intellect understands just enough to know that for the intellect it is—wholly and completely unintelligible).—But precisely because we are people who seek knowledge, we should finally not be ungrateful for such determined reversals of customary perspectives and evaluations with which the spirit has for so long raged against itself with such apparent wickedness and futility. To use this for once to see differently, the will to see things differently, is no small discipline and preparation of the intellect for its coming “objectivity”—the latter meant not in the sense of “disinterested contemplation” (which is inconceivable nonsense), but as the capability of having power over one’s positive and negative arguments and of raising them and disposing of them so that one knows how to make the very variety of perspectives and interpretations of emotions useful for knowledge. From now on, my philosophical gentlemen, let us protect ourselves better from the dangerous old conceptual fantasy which posits a “pure, will-less, painless, timeless subject of cognition”; let’s guard ourselves against the tentacles of such contradictory ideas as “pure reason,” “absolute spirituality,” “knowledge in itself”—those things which demand that we think of an eye which simply cannot be imagined, an eye which is to have no direction at all, in which the active and interpretative forces are supposed to stop or be absent—the very things through which seeing first becomes seeing something. Hence, these things always demand from the eye something conceptually absurd and incomprehensible. The only seeing we have is seeing from a perspective; the only knowledge we have is knowledge from a perspective; and the more emotions we allow to be expressed in words concerning something, the more eyes, different eyes, we know how to train on the same thing, the more complete our “idea” of this thing, our “objectivity,” will be. But to eliminate the will in

general, to suspend all our emotions without exception—even if we were capable of that—what would that be? Wouldn't we call that castrating the intellect? 13 But let's go back to our problem. The sort of self-contradiction which seems to be present in ascetic people, "life opposing life," is—this much is clear—physiologically (and not only physiologically) considered—simply absurd. It can only be apparent. It must be some kind of temporary expression, an interpretation, formula, make up, a psychological misunderstanding of something whose real nature could not be understood for a long time, could not for a long time be described in itself—a mere word, caught in an old gap in human understanding. So let me counter that briefly with the facts of the matter: the ascetic ideal arises out of the instinct for protection and salvation in a degenerating life, which seeks to keep itself going by any means and struggles for its existence. It indicates a partial physiological inhibition and exhaustion, against which those deepest instincts for living which still remain intact continuously fight on with new methods and innovations. The ascetic ideal is one such method. The facts are thus precisely the opposite of what those who honour this ideal claim—life is struggling in that ideal and by means of that ideal with death and against death: the ascetic ideal is a manoeuvre for the preservation of life. As history teaches us, to the extent that this ideal could prevail over men and become powerful, particularly wherever civilization and the taming of humans have been successfully implemented, it expresses an important fact: the pathological nature of the earlier form of human beings, at least of those human beings who had been tamed, the physiological struggle of men against death (more precisely, against weariness with life, against exhaustion, against desire for the "end"). The ascetic priest is the incarnation of the desire for another state of being, an existence somewhere else—indeed, the highest stage of this desire, its characteristic zeal and passion. But the very power of this desire is the chain which binds him here. That's simply what turns him into a tool which has to work to create more favourable conditions for living here and for living as a human being—with this very power he keeps the whole herd of failures, discontents, delinquents, unfortunates, all sorts of people who inherently suffer, focussed on existence, because instinctively he goes ahead of them as their herdsman. You understand already what I mean: this ascetic priest, this apparent enemy of living, this man who denies—he belongs precisely with all the great conserving and affirming forces of life. . . . To what can we ascribe this pathology? For the human being is more ill, less certain, more changeable, more insecure than any other animal—there's no doubt about that. He is the sick animal. Where does that come from? To be sure, he has also dared more, innovated more, defied more, and demanded more from fate than all the other animals combined. He is the great experimenter with himself, unhappy, dissatisfied, who struggles for ultimate mastery with animals, nature, and gods—

still unconquered, always a man of the future, who no longer gets any rest from the force of his own powers, so that his future relentlessly burrows like a thorn into the flesh of his entire present:—how should such a brave and rich animal not also be the animal in most danger, the one which, of all sick animals, suffers the most lengthy and most profound illness? Human beings, often enough, get fed up: there are entire epidemics of this process of getting fed up (—for example, around 1348, at the time of the dance of death): but even this very disgust, this exhaustion, this dissatisfaction with himself—all this comes out of him so powerfully that it immediately becomes a new chain. The No which he speaks to life brings to light, as if through a magic spell, an abundance of more tender Yeses; in fact, when he injures himself, this master of destruction, of self-destruction—it is the wound itself which later forces him to live on. . . . 14 The more normal this pathology is among human beings—and we cannot deny its normality—the higher we should esteem the rare cases of spiritual and physical power, humanity's strokes of luck, and the more strongly successful people should protect themselves from the most poisonous air, the atmosphere of illness. Do people do that? . . . Sick people are the greatest danger for healthy people. For strong people disaster does not come from the strongest, but from the weakest. Are we aware of that? . . . If we consider the big picture, we should not wish for any diminution of the fear we have of human beings, for this fear compels the strong people to be strong and, in some circumstances, terrible—that fear sustains the successful types of people. What we should fear, what has a disastrous effect unlike any other, would not be a great fear of humanity but a great loathing for humanity; similarly, a great pity for humanity. If both of these were one day to mate, then something most weird would at once inevitably appear in the world, the “ultimate will” of man, his will to nothingness, to nihilism. And, as a matter of fact, a great deal of preparation has gone on for this union. Whoever possesses, not only a nose to smell with, but also eyes and ears, senses almost everywhere, no matter where he steps nowadays, an atmosphere something like that of an insane asylum or hospital—I'm speaking, as usual, of people's cultural surroundings, of every kind of “Europe” there is right here on this earth. The invalids are the great danger to humanity: not the evil men, not the “predatory animals.” Those people who are, from the outset, failures, oppressed, broken—they are the ones, the weakest, who most undermine life among human beings, who in the most perilous way poison and question our trust in life, in humanity, in ourselves. Where can we escape it, that downcast glance with which people carry a deep sorrow, that reversed gaze of the man originally born to fail which betrays how such a man speaks to himself—that gaze which is a sigh. “I wish I could be someone else!”—that's what this glance sighs. “But there is no hope here. I am who I am. How could I detach myself from myself? And yet—I've had enough of myself!” . . . On such a ground of contempt for oneself, a truly

swampy ground, grows every weed, every poisonous growth, and all of them so small, so hidden, so dishonest, so sweet. Here the worms of angry and resentful feelings swarm; here the air stinks of secrets and duplicity; here are constantly spun the nets of the most malicious conspiracies—the plotting of suffering people against the successful and victorious; here the appearance of the victor is despised. And what dishonesty not to acknowledge this hatred as hatred! What an extravagance of large words and postures, what an art of “decent” slander! These failures: what noble eloquence streams from their lips! How much sugary, slimy, humble resignation swims in their eyes! What do they really want? At least to make a show of justice, love, wisdom, superiority—that’s the ambition of these “lowest” people, these invalids! And how clever such an ambition makes people! For let’s admire the skillful counterfeiting with which people here imitate the trademarks of virtue, even its resounding tinkle, the golden sound of virtue. They have now taken a lease on virtue entirely for themselves, these weak and hopeless invalids—there’s no doubt about that: “We alone are the good men, the just men”—that’s how they speak: “We alone are the *homines bonae voluntatis* [men of good will].” They wander around among us like personifications of reproach, like warnings to us—as if health, success, strength, pride, and a feeling of power were already inherently depraved things, for which people must atone some day, atone bitterly. O how ready they themselves basically are to make people atone, how they thirst to be hangmen! Among them there are plenty of people disguised as judges seeking revenge. They always have the word “Justice” in their mouths, like poisonous saliva, with their mouths always pursed, always ready to spit at anything which does not look discontented and goes on its way in good spirits. Among them there is no lack of that most disgusting species of vain people, the lying monsters who aim to present themselves as “beautiful souls” and who, for example, carry off to market their ruined sensuality, wrapped up in verse and other swaddling clothes, as “purity of heart,” the species of self-gratifying moral masturbators. The desire of sick people to present some form or other of superiority, their instinct for secret paths leading to a tyranny over the healthy—where can we not find it, this very will to power of the weakest people! The sick woman, in particular: no one outdoes her in refined ways to rule others, to exert pressure, to tyrannize. For that purpose, the sick woman spares nothing living or dead. She digs up again the most deeply buried things (the Bogos say “The woman is a hyena”). Take a look into the background of every family, every corporation, every community: everywhere you see the struggle of the sick against the healthy—a quiet struggle, for the most part, with a little poison powder, with needling, with deceitful expressions of long suffering, but now and then also with that sick man’s Pharisaic tactic of loud gestures, whose favourite role is “noble indignation.” It likes to make itself heard all the way into the consecrated rooms of science, that hoarse, booming indignation of the

pathologically ill hound, the biting insincerity and rage of such “noble” Pharisees (—once again I remind readers who have ears of Eugene Dühring, that apostle of revenge from Berlin, who in today’s Germany makes the most indecent and most revolting use of moralistic gibberish [Bumbum]—Dühring, the pre-eminent moral braggart we have nowadays, even among those like him, the anti-Semites). (11) They are all men of ressentiment, these physiologically impaired and worm-eaten men, a totally quivering earthly kingdom of subterranean revenge, inexhaustible, insatiable in its outbursts against the fortunate, and equally in its masquerades of revenge, its pretexts for revenge. When would they truly attain their ultimate, most refined, most sublime triumph of revenge? Undoubtedly, if they could succeed in pushing their own wretchedness, all misery in general, into the consciences of the fortunate, so that the latter one day might begin to be ashamed of their good fortune and perhaps would say to themselves, “It’s shameful to be fortunate. There’s too much misery!”. . . But there could be no greater and more fateful misunderstanding than if, through this process, the fortunate, the successful, the powerful in body and spirit should start to doubt their right to happiness. Away with this “twisted world”! Away with this disgraceful softening of feelings! That the invalids do not make the healthy sick —and that would be such a softening—that should surely be ruling point of view on earth:—but that would require above everything that the healthy remain separated from the sick, protected even from the gaze of sick people, so that they don’t confuse themselves with the ill. Or would it perhaps be their assignment to attend on the sick or be their doctors? . . . But they could not misjudge or negate their work more seriously—something higher must not demean itself by becoming the tool of something lower. The pathos of distance must keep the work of the two groups forever separate! Their right to exist, the privilege of a bell with a perfect ring in comparison to one that is cracked and off key, is indeed a thousand times greater. They alone are the guarantors of the future; they alone stand as pledge for humanity’s future. Whatever they can do, whatever they should do—the sick can never to do and should not do. But so that they are able to do what only they should do, how can they have the freedom to make themselves the doctor, the consoler, the “person who cures” for the invalids? . . . And therefore let’s have fresh air! fresh air! In any case, let’s keep away from the neighbourhood of all cultural insane asylums and hospitals! And for that let’s have good companionship, our companionship! Or loneliness, if that’s necessary! But by all means let’s stay away from the foul stink of inner rotting and of the secret muck from sick worms! In that way, my friends, we can defend ourselves, at least for a while, against the two nastiest scourges which may be lying in wait precisely for us—against a great disgust with humanity and against a great pity for humanity! 15 If you’ve grasped the full profundity of this—and precisely here I require that you grasp deeply, understand profoundly—of the extent to

which it simply cannot be the task of healthy people to attend to the sick, to make invalids well, then you've understood one more necessary matter—the necessity for doctors and nurses who are themselves ill. And now we have the meaning of the ascetic priest—we're holding it in both hands. We need to look on the ascetic priest as the preordained healer, shepherd, and advocate of the sick herd; in that way we can, for the first time, understand his immense historical mission. The ruling power over suffering people is his kingdom. His instinct instructs him to do that; in that he has his very own art, his mastery, his sort of success. He must be sick himself; he must be fundamentally related to the sick and those who go astray, in order to understand them—in order to be understood among them. But he must also be strong, master over himself even more than over others, that is, undamaged in his will to power, so that he inspires the confidence and fear of the invalids, so that he can be their support, resistance, protection, compulsion, discipline, tyrant, god. He has to defend his herd, but against whom? Against the healthy people undoubtedly, also against their envy of the healthy. He has to be the natural opponent and critic of all rough, stormy, unchecked, hard, violent, predatory health and power. The priest is the first form of the more delicate animal which despises more easily than it hates. He will not be spared having to conduct war with predatory animals, a war of cunning (of the “spirit”) rather than of force, as is obvious—for that purpose, in certain circumstances it will be necessary for him to develop himself almost into a new type of beast of prey, or at least to represent himself as such a beast—with a new animal ferocity in which the polar bear, the sleek, cold, and patient tiger, and, not least, the fox seem to be combined in a unity which attracts just as much as it inspires fear. If need compels him to, he will walk even in the midst of the other sort of predatory animals with the seriousness of a bear, venerable, clever, cold, and with a duplicitous superiority, as the herald and oracle of more mysterious forces, determined to sow this ground, where he can, with suffering, conflict, self-contradiction, and only too sure of his art, to become the master over suffering people at all times. There's no doubt he brings with him ointments and balm. But in order to be a doctor, he first has to inflict wounds. Then, while he eases the pain caused by the wound, at the same time he poisons the wound—for that is, above all, what he knows how to do, this magician and animal trainer, around whom everything healthy necessarily becomes ill and everything sick necessarily becomes tame. In fact, he defends his sick herd well enough, this strange shepherd—he protects them also against themselves, against the smouldering wickedness, scheming, and maliciousness in the herd itself, against all those addictions and illnesses characteristic of their associating with each other. He fights shrewdly, hard, and secretly against the anarchy and self-dissolution which start up all the time within the herd, in which that most dangerous explosive stuff and blasting material, resentment, is constantly piling and piling up. To

detonate this explosive stuff in such a way that it does not blow up the herd and its shepherd, that is his essential work of art and also his most important use. If we want to sum up the value of the priestly existence in the shortest slogan, we could at once put it like this: the priest is the person who alters the direction of resentment. For every suffering person instinctively seeks a cause for his suffering, or, more precisely, an agent, or, even more precisely, a guilty agent sensitive to suffering—in short, he seeks some living person on whom he can, on some pretext or other, unload his feelings, either in fact or in effigy: for the discharge of feelings is the most important way a suffering man seeks relief—that is, some anaesthetic—it's his involuntarily desired narcotic against any kind of torment. In my view, only here can we find the true physiological cause of resentment, revenge, and things related to them, in a longing for some anaesthetic against pain through one's emotions. People usually look for this cause, most incorrectly, in my opinion, in the defensive striking back, a merely reactive protective measure, a "reflex movement" in the event of some sudden damage and threat, of the sort a decapitated frog still makes in order to get rid of corrosive acid. But the difference is fundamental: in one case, people want to prevent suffering further damage; in the other case, people want to deaden a tormenting, secret pain which is becoming unendurable by means of a more violent emotion of some kind and, for the moment at least, to drive it from their consciousness—for that they need some emotion, as unruly an emotion as possible, and, in order to stimulate that, they need the best pretext available. "Someone or other must be guilty of the fact that I am ill"—this sort of conclusion is characteristic of all sick people, all the more so if the real cause of their sense that they are sick, the physiological cause, remains hidden (—it can lie, for example, in an illness of the *nervus sympathicus* [sympathetic nerve], or in an excessive secretion of gall, or in a lack of potassium sulphate and phosphate in the blood, or in some pressure in the lower abdomen, which blocks the circulation, or in a degeneration of the ovaries, and so on). Suffering people all have a horrible willingness and capacity for inventing pretexts for painful emotional feelings. They enjoy even their suspicions, their brooding over bad actions and apparent damage. They ransack the entrails of their past and present, looking for dark, dubious stories, in which they are free to feast on an agonizing suspicion and to get intoxicated on the poison of their own anger—they rip open the oldest wounds, they bleed themselves to death from long-healed scars, they turn friends, wives, children, and anyone else who is closest to them into criminals. "I am suffering. Someone or other must be to blame for that"—that's how every sick sheep thinks. But his shepherd, the ascetic priest, says to him: "That's right, my sheep! Someone must be to blame for that. But you yourself are this very person. You yourself are the only one to blame—you alone are to blame for yourself!" . . . That is bold enough, and false enough. But one thing at

least is attained by that, as I have said, the direction of resentment has been—changed. 16 By now you will have guessed what, according to my ideas, the healing artistic instinct for life at least has attempted with the ascetic priest and why he had to use a temporary tyranny of such paradoxical and illogical ideas, like “guilt,” “sins,” “sinfulness,” “degeneration,” and “damnation”: to make sick people to a certain extent harmless, to enable the incurable to destroy themselves by their own actions, to redirect the resentment of the mildly ill sternly back onto themselves (“there’s one thing necessary”—), and in this manner to utilize the bad instincts of all suffering people to serve the purpose of self-discipline, self-monitoring, self-conquest. As is obvious, this kind of “medication,” a merely emotional medication, has nothing at all to do with a real cure for an illness, in a physiological sense. We are never entitled to assert that the instinct for life has any sort of chance or intention to heal itself in this way. A kind of pressure to come together and organize the invalids on one side (—the word “church” is the popular name for this), some form of temporary guarantee for the more healthy successful people, the ones more completely fulfilled, on another side, and in the process the creation of rift between the healthy and sick—for a long time that’s all there was. And that was a lot! It was a great deal! (In this essay, as you see, I proceed on an assumption which, so far as the readers I require are concerned, I do not have to prove first—that the “sinfulness” of human beings is not a matter of fact, but much rather only the interpretation of a factual condition, that is, of a bad psychological mood—with the latter seen from a moral-religious perspective, something which is no longer binding on us.—The fact that someone feels himself “guilty” or “sinful” does not in itself yet demonstrate clearly that he is justified in feeling like that, just as the mere fact that someone feels healthy does not mean that he is healthy. People should remember the famous witch trials: at that time the most perspicacious and philanthropic judges had no doubt that they were dealing with guilt; the “witches” themselves had no doubts about that point—nonetheless, there was no guilt.—To express that assumption in broader terms: I consider that “spiritual pain” itself is not, in general, a fact, but only an interpretation (a causal interpretation) of facts which up to that point have not been precisely formulated, and thus something that is still completely up in the air and not scientifically binding—essentially a fat word set in place of a very spindly question mark. To put the matter crudely, when someone cannot cope with a “spiritual pain,” that has nothing to do with his “soul”; it’s more likely something to do with his belly (speaking crudely, as I said: but in saying that I’m not expressing the slightest wish to be crudely heard or crudely understood . . .). A strong and successful man digests his experiences (his actions, including his evil actions) as he digests his meals, even when he has to swallow down some hard mouthfuls. If he is “unable to finish with” an experience, this kind of indigestion is just as much a physiological matter as that

other one—and in many cases, in fact, only one of the consequences of that other one.—With such an view, a person can, just between ourselves, still be the strongest opponent of all materialism. . . .) 17 But is he really a doctor, this ascetic priest?—We already understand the extent to which one can hardly be permitted to call him a doctor, no matter how much he likes feeling that he is a “saviour” and allowing himself to be honoured as a “saviour.” But he fights only against suffering itself, the unhappiness of the suffering person, not against its cause, not against the essential sickness—this must constitute our most fundamental objection to priestly medication. But if for once we look at things from the perspective which only the priest understands and adopts, then it will not be easy for us to limit our amazement at all the things he has noticed, looked for, and found by seeing things in that manner. The alleviation of suffering, every kind of “consolation”—that manifests itself as his particular genius: he has understood his task as consoler with so much innovation and has selected the means for that so spontaneously and so fearlessly! We could call Christianity, in particular, a huge treasure house of the most elegant forms of consolation —there are so many pleasant, soothing, narcotizing things piled up in it, and for this purpose it takes so many of the most dangerous and most audacious chances. It shows such sophistication, such southern refinement, especially when it guesses what kind of emotional stimulant can overcome, at least for a while, the deep depression, leaden exhaustion, and black sorrow of the physiologically impaired. For, generally speaking, with all great religions, the main issue concerns the fight against a certain endemic exhaustion and heaviness. We can from the outset assume as probable that from time to time, in particular places on the earth, a feeling of physiological inhibition must necessarily become master over wide masses of people, but, because of a lack of knowledge about physiology, it does not enter people’s consciousness as something physiological, so they look for and attempt to find its “cause” and remedy only in psychology and morality (—this, in fact, is my most general formula for whatever is commonly called a “religion”). Such a feeling of inhibition can have a varied ancestry; for instance, it can be the result of cross-breeding between different races (or between classes —for classes also always express differences in origin and race: European “Weltschmerz” [pain at the state of the world] and nineteenth-century “pessimism” are essentially the consequence of an irrational, sudden mixing of the classes), or it can be caused by incorrect emigration—a race caught in a climate for which its powers of adaptation are not sufficient (the case of the Indians in India); or by the influence of the age and exhaustion of the race (Parisian pessimism from 1850 on); or by an incorrect diet (the alcoholism of the Middle Ages, the inanity of vegetarians, who, of course, have on their side the authority of Squire Christopher in Shakespeare); or by degeneration in the blood, malaria, syphilis and things like that (German depression after the Thirty Years’

War, which spread bad diseases in an epidemic through half of Germany and thus prepared the ground for German servility, German timidity).(12) In such a case, a war against the feeling of a lack of enthusiasm will always be attempted in the grand style. Let's briefly go over its most important practices and forms. (Here I leave quite out of account, as seems reasonable, the actual war of the philosophers against this lack of enthusiasm, which always has a habit of appearing at the same time—that war is interesting enough, but too absurd, with too little practical significance, too full of cobwebs and loafing around—as, for example, when pain is to be shown an error, on the naive assumption that the pain must disappear as soon as it is recognized as an error—but, lo and behold, it seems to it that it does not disappear . . .). First, people fight that domineering listlessness with means which, in general, set our feeling for life at their lowest point. Where possible, there is generally no more willing, no more desire; they stay away from everything which creates an emotional response, which makes “blood” (no salt in the diet, the hygiene of the fakir); they don't love; they don't hate—equanimity—they don't take revenge, they don't get wealthy, they don't work; they beg; where possible, no women, or as few women as possible; with respect to spiritual matters, Pascal's principle “Il faut s'abêtir” [it's necessary to make oneself stupid]. The result, expressed in moral-psychological terms, is “selflessness,” “sanctification”; expressed in physiological terms: hypnotizing—the attempt to attain for human beings something approaching what winter hibernation is for some kinds of animals and what summer sleep is for many plants in hot climates, the minimum consumption and processing of material stuff which can still sustain life but which does not actually enter consciousness. For this purpose an astonishing amount of human energy has been expended. Has it all gone for nothing? . . . We should not entertain the slightest doubts that such sportsmen of “holiness,” whom almost all populations have in abundance at all times, in fact found a real release from what they were fighting against with such a rigorous training—with the help of their systemic methods for hypnosis, in countless cases they really were released from that deep physiological depression. That's the reason their methodology belongs with the most universal ethnological facts. For the same reason, we have no authority for considering such an intentional starving of one's desires and of one's physical well being as, in itself, symptoms of insanity (the way a clumsy kind of roast-beef-eating “free spirit” and Squire Christopher like to do). It's much more the case that it opens or can open the way to all sorts of spiritual disruptions, to “inner light,” for example, as with Hesychasts on Mount Athos, to hallucinating sounds and shapes, to sensual outpourings and ecstasies of sensuality (the history of St. Theresa).(13) It's self-evident that the interpretation which has been given for conditions of this sort by those afflicted with them has always been as effusively false as possible. Still, people should not fail to catch the tone of totally

convincing gratitude ringing out in the very will to such a form of interpretation. They always value the highest state, redemption itself, that finally attained collective hypnosis and quietness, as the inherent mystery, which cannot be adequately expressed even by the highest symbols, as a stop at and return home to the basis of things, as an emancipation from all delusions, as “knowledge,” as “truth,” as “being,” as the removal of all goals, all wishes, all acts, and thus as a place beyond good and evil. “Good and evil,” says the Buddhist, “are both fetters: the perfect one became master over both”; “what’s done and what’s not done,” says the man who believes in the Vedanta, “give him no pain; as a wise man he shakes good and evil off himself; his kingdom suffers no more from any deed; good and evil—he has transcended both”—an entirely Indian conception, whether Brahman or Buddhist. (Neither in the Indian nor in the Christian way of thinking is this “redemption” considered attainable through virtue, through moral improvement—no matter how high a value they place on virtue as a form of hypnotism. People should note this point—it corresponds, incidentally, to the plain facts. That on this point they kept to the truth might perhaps be considered the best piece of realism in the three largest religions, which, apart from this, are religions so fundamentally concerned with moralizing. “The man who knows has no duties” . . . “Redemption does not come about through an increase in virtue, for it consists of unity with Brahma, who is incapable of any increase in perfection; even less does it come through setting aside one’s faults, for the Brahma, unity with whom creates redemption, is eternally pure”—these passages from the commentary of Shankara are cited by the first genuine authority on Indian philosophy in Europe, my friend Paul Deussen).(14) So we want to honour “redemption” in the great religions; however, it will be a little difficult for us to remain serious about the way these people, who’ve grown too weary of life even to dream, value deep sleep—that is, deep sleep as already an access to the Brahma, as an achieved unio mystica [mysterious union] with God. On this subject, the oldest and most venerable “Scripture” states: “When he is soundly and completely asleep and is in a state of perfect calm, so that he is not seeing any more dream images, at that moment, O dear one, united with Being, he has gone into himself—now that he has been embraced by a form of his knowing self, he has no consciousness any more of what is outer or inner. Over this bridge comes neither night nor day, nor old age, nor death, nor suffering, nor good works, nor evil works.” Similarly, believers in this most profound of the three great religions say, “In deep sleep the soul lifts itself up out of this body, goes into the highest light, and moves out in its own form: there it is the highest spirit itself which wanders around, while it jokes and plays and enjoys itself, whether with women or with carriages or with friends; there it no longer thinks back to its bodily appendages, to which the prana (the breath of life) is harnessed like a draught animal to a cart.” Nevertheless, as in the case of “redemption,” we also

need to keep in mind here that no matter how great the splendour of oriental exaggeration, what this states is basically the same evaluation which was made by that clear, cool, Greek-cool, but suffering Epicurus: the hypnotic feeling of nothingness, the silence of the deepest sleep, in short, the loss of suffering—something which suffering and fundamentally disgruntled people are already entitled to consider their highest good, their value of values, and which they must appraise as positive and experience as the positive in itself. (With the same logic of feeling, in all pessimistic religions nothingness is called God). 18 Against this condition of depression, a different and certainly easier training is tried far more often than such a hypnotic collective deadening of the sensibilities, of the ability to experience pain, for the method requires rare powers, above all, courage, contempt for opinion, and “intellectual stoicism.” This different training is mechanical activity. There’s no doubt whatsoever that this can alleviate a suffering existence to a degree which is not insignificant. Today we call this fact, somewhat dishonestly, “the blessings of work.” The relief comes about because the interest of the suffering person is basically diverted from his suffering—because some action and then another action are always entering his consciousness, thus leaving little space there for suffering. For it’s narrow, this room of human consciousness! Mechanical activity and what’s associated with it—like absolute regularity, meticulous and mindless obedience, a style of life set once and for all, filling in time, a certain allowance for, indeed, training in, “impersonality,” in forgetting oneself, in “incuria sui” [no care for oneself]—how fundamentally, how delicately the ascetic priest knew how to use them in the struggle with suffering! Especially when it involved the suffering people of the lower classes, working slaves, or prisoners (or women, most of whom are, in fact, simultaneously both working slaves and prisoners) what was needed was little more than the minor art of changing names and re-christening, so as to make those people in future see a favour, some relative good fortune, in things they hated—the slave’s discontent with his lot, in any case, was not invented by the priests. An even more valuable tool in the battle against depression is prescribing a small pleasure which is readily accessible and can be made habitual. People frequently use this medication in combination with the one just mentioned. The most common form in which pleasure is prescribed in this way as a cure is the pleasure in creating pleasure (as in showing kindness, giving presents, providing relief, helping, encouraging, trusting, praising, honouring). The ascetic priest orders “love of one’s neighbour”; in so doing, he is basically prescribing an arousal of the strongest, most life-affirming drive, even if only in the most cautious doses—the will to power. The happiness which comes from “the smallest feeling of superiority,” which all doing good, being useful, helping, and honouring bring with them, is the most plentiful way of providing consolation, which the physiologically impaired habitually use, provided that

they have been well advised. In a different situation, they harm each other, doing so, of course, in obedience to the same basic instinct. If we look for the beginnings of Christianity in the Roman world, we find organizations growing up for mutual support, combinations of the poor and sick, for burial, on the lowest levels of society at the time, in which that major way of combating depression, the minor joys which habitually develop out of mutual demonstrations of kindness, were consciously employed—perhaps at the time this was something new, a real discovery? “The will to mutual assistance,” to the formation of the herd, to “a community,” to “a congregation,” summoned in this manner, must call up again, if only in the smallest way, that aroused will to power and come to a new and much greater outburst. In the fight against depression, the development of the herd is an essential step and a victory. By growing, the community also reinforces in the individual a new interest, which often enough raises him up over the most personal features of his bad disposition, his dislike of himself (Geulincx’s *despectio sui* [contempt for oneself]).(15) All sick pathological people, in their desire to shake off a stifling lack of enthusiasm and a feeling of weakness, instinctively strive for the organization of a herd. The ascetic priest senses this instinct and promotes it. Where there is a herd, it’s the instinct of weakness which has willed the herd and the cleverness of the priest which has organized it. For we should not overlook the following point: through natural necessity strong people strive to separate from each other, just as much as weak people strive to be with each other. When the former unite, that happens only at the prospect of an aggressive combined action and a collective satisfaction of their will to power, with considerable resistance from the individual conscience. By contrast, the latter organize themselves collectively, taking pleasure precisely in this collective—their instinct is satisfied by this in the same way that the instinct of those born “Masters” (i.e., the solitary man of the predatory species of human being) is basically irritated and upset by organization. Under every oligarchy—all history teaches us—is always concealed the craving for tyranny. Every oligarchy is constantly trembling with the tension which every individual in it necessarily has in order to remain master of this craving. (That was the case, for example, with the Greeks. Plato provides evidence of this in a hundred passages—Plato, who understood his peers—and himself . . .). 19 The ascetic priest’s methods, which we learned about earlier—the collective deadening of the feeling for life, mechanical activity, minor joys, above all, the joy in “loving one’s neighbour,” the organization of the herd, the awakening of the feeling of power in the community, as a result of which the dissatisfaction of the individual with himself is drowned out by his pleasure in the flourishing of the community— these things are, measured by modern standards, his innocent methods in the war against unhappiness. But now let’s turn our attention to more interesting

methods, to his “guilty” ones. With all of them there is one thing involved: some kind of excess of feeling—employed as the most effective anaesthetic against stifling, crippling, and long-lasting pain. For that reason, the priest’s powers of innovation have been tireless in addressing this one question in particular: “Through what means do people reach emotional excess?” . . . That sounds harsh. It’s clear enough that it would sound more appealing and perhaps please our ears better if I said something like “The ascetic priest has always used the enthusiasm which lies in all strong emotions.” But why keep caressing the mollicoddled ears of our modern delicate sensibilities? Why should we, for our part, retreat even one step back from the Tartufferie [hypocrisy] of their vocabulary? Doing something like that would already make us psychologists active hypocrites—apart from the fact that for us it would be disgusting. For if a psychologist today has good taste anywhere (others might say his honesty), it’s because he detests that disgraceful moralizing way of talking, which effectively covers in slime all modern judgments about human beings and things. For we must not deceive ourselves in this business. The most characteristic feature which forms modern souls and modern books is not lying but the ingrained innocence in their moralistic lying. To have to discover this “innocence” again all over the place—that is perhaps the most repellent part of our work, of all the inherently dangerous work which nowadays a psychologist has to undertake. It is a part of our great danger—it is a path that perhaps takes us in particular to a great revulsion. I have no doubt about what single purpose will be served, or can be served, in a coming world by modern books (provided they last, which, of course, we need not fear, and provided there will one day be a later world with a stronger, harder, and healthier taste), or what general purpose all things modern will have: they will serve as emetics—and they’ll do that thanks to their moralistic sugar and falsity, their innermost femininity, which likes to call itself “idealism” and which, at all events, has faith in idealism. Today our educated people, our “good people,” don’t tell lies—that’s true. But that’s no reason to respect them! The real lie, the genuine, resolute, “honest” lie (people should listen to Plato on its value) for them would be something far too demanding, too strong. It would require what people are not allowed to demand of them, that they opened up their eyes and looked at themselves, so that they would know how to differentiate between “true” and “false” with respect to themselves. But they are fit only for ignoble lies. Everyone today who feels that he is a “good man” is completely incapable of taking a stand on any issue at all, other than with dishonest falseness—an abysmal falsity, which is, however, innocent falsity, true-hearted falsity, blue-eyed falsity, virtuous falsity. These “good people”—collectively they are now utterly and completely moralized and, so far as their honesty is concerned, they’ve been disgraced and ruined for all eternity. Who among them could endure even one truth “about human beings”? . . . Or, to ask

the question more precisely, who among them could bear a true biography! Here are a couple of indications: Lord Byron recorded some very personal things about himself, but Thomas Moore was “too good” for them. He burned his friend’s papers. The executor of Schopenhauer’s will, Dr. Gwinner, is alleged to have done the same thing, for Schopenhauer had also recorded some things about himself and also perhaps against himself (“eis auton” [against himself]). The capable American Thayer, the biographer of Beethoven, all of a sudden stopped his work: at some point or other in this venerable and naive life he could no longer continue . . . Moral: What intelligent man nowadays would still write an honest word about himself?—He would already have to be a member of the Order of Holy Daredevils. We have been promised an autobiography of Richard Wagner. Who has any doubts that it will be a prudent autobiography?(16) Let’s remember the comical horror which the Catholic priest Janssen aroused in Germany with his incomprehensibly bland and harmless picture of the German Reformation movement. How would people react if one day someone explained this movement differently, if, for once, a true psychologist with spiritual strength and not a shrewd indulgence toward strength pictured a true Luther for us, no longer with the moralistic simplicity of a country parson, no longer with the sweet and considerate modesty of a protestant historian, but with something like the fearlessness of a Taine? . . . (Parenthetically, the Germans have finally produced a sufficiently beautiful classical type of such shrewd indulgence—they can classify him as one of their own and be proud of him, namely, their Leopold Ranke, this born classical advocate of every causa fortior [stronger cause], the shrewdest of all the shrewd “realists”).(17) 20 But you will already have grasped what I’m getting at. All in all, that’s surely reason enough, is it not, why we psychologists nowadays cannot rid ourselves of a certain distrust in ourselves? . . . We also are probably “too good” for the work we do. We are probably sacrificial victims and prey, as well, made sick by this contemporary taste for moralizing, no matter how much we also feel we’re its critics—it probably infects even us as well. What was that diplomat warning about, when he addressed his colleagues? “Gentlemen, let us mistrust our first impulses above all!” he declared; “they are almost always good.” That’s also how every psychologist today should speak to his peers. And so we come back to our problem, which, in fact, requires a certain rigour from us, especially some distrust of our “first impulses.” The ascetic ideal in the service of intentional emotional excess—whoever remembers the previous essay will, with the compressed content of these ten words, already have a preliminary sense of the essential content of what I now have to demonstrate. To remove the human soul for once from its entire frame, to immerse it in terror, frost, glowing embers, and joys of that kind, so that it rids itself, as if with a bolt of lightning, of all pettiness and small-mindedness of lack of interest, apathy, and irritation. What paths lead

to this goal? And which of them is the most reliable? . . . All the greatest emotions basically have this capacity, provided they discharge themselves suddenly—anger, fear, lust, revenge, hope, triumph, despair, cruelty. And the ascetic priest has, in fact, without a second thought, taken the entire pack of wild hounds in the human being into his service and let loose one of them at one time, another at another time, always for the same purpose, to wake human beings up out of their long sadness, to chase away, at least for a while, their stifling pain, their tentative misery, and always covered up in a religious interpretation and “justification.” Every emotional excess of this sort demands payment later; that’s self-evident—it makes sick people sicker. And thus, this way of providing a remedy for pain, measured by modern standards, is a “guilty” method. However, to be fair, we must insist all the more that it was used in good conscience, that the ascetic priest prescribed it with the deepest faith in its utility, indeed, its indispensability—often enough almost falling apart himself in front of the misery he created; and, similarly, that the vehement physiological revenges of such excesses, perhaps even psychic disturbances, basically do not really contradict the whole meaning of this kind of medication, which, as I’ve pointed out above, was not designed to heal sick people, but to fight their enervating depression, to alleviate and anaesthetize it. With this method that goal was attained. The main instrumental fingering which the ascetic priest allowed himself in order to bring every kind of disorienting ecstatic music ringing out in the human soul was achieved, as everyone knows, by the fact that he made use of the feeling of guilt. The previous essay indicated, in brief, the origin of this feeling—as a part of animal psychology, nothing more. The feeling of guilt we encountered there in its raw state, as it were. In the hands of the priest, this true artist in guilt feelings, it first acquired a form—and what a form! “Sin”—for that’s how the priest’s new interpretation of the animal “bad conscience” ran (cruelty turned backwards)—has been the greatest event in the history of the sick soul so far. In it we have the most dangerous and the most fateful artistic work of religious interpretation. The human being, suffering from himself somehow—at any rate, psychologically—something like an animal barred up in a cage, confused about why this has happened and what purpose it serves, longing for reasons—reasons provide relief—longing also for treatments and narcotics, finally discussed the matter with one who also knew about hidden things—and lo and behold! He gets a hint. He gets the first hint about the “cause” of his suffering from his magician, the ascetic priest. He is to seek this cause in himself, in his guilt, in a piece of the past. He is to understand his own suffering as a condition of punishment . . . He heard, he understood—this unfortunate man: now things stand with him as with a hen around which a line has been drawn. He is not to come outside this circle of lines again. The “sick man” is turned into the “sinner” . . . And now for a couple of millennia people have not rid themselves of the look of this new sick man, the

“sinner.”—Will people ever be rid of him?—No matter where we look, we see everywhere the hypnotic glance of the sinner, who always moves in one direction (in the direction of “guilt” as the single cause of suffering), everywhere the bad conscience, this “horrifying animal,” to use Luther’s words, everywhere the past regurgitated, the fact distorted, the “green eye” cast on all action, everywhere the desire to misunderstand suffering turned into the meaning of life, with suffering reinterpreted into feelings of guilt, fear, and punishment, everywhere the whip, the hair shirt, the starving body, remorse, everywhere the sinner’s breaking himself on the terrible torture wheel of a restless conscience, greedy for its own sickness; everywhere silent torment, extreme fear, the agony of the tortured heart, the spasms of an unknown joy, the cry for “redemption.” As a matter of fact, with this system of procedures the old depression, heaviness, and exhaustion were basically overthrown. Life became very interesting once again: lively, always lively, sleepless, glowing, charred, exhausted, and yet not tired—that’s how man looked, the “sinner,” who was initiated into these mysteries. This grand old magician in the war against the lack of excitement, the ascetic priest—he had apparently won. His kingdom had come. Now people no longer moaned against pain; they longed for pain: “More pain! More pain!”—that had been the demanding cry of his disciples and initiates for centuries. Every excess of feeling which brought grief, everything that broke apart, knocked over, smashed to bits, carried away, enraptured, the secrets of the torture chambers, the very invention of hell—from now on everything was discovered, surmised, put into practice. Everything now was available for the magician’s use. Everything in future served for the victory of his ideal, the ascetic ideal. . . . “My empire is not of this world”—he said afterwards (as he said before). Does he really have the right still to speak this way? . . . Goethe asserted that there were only thirty-six tragic situations. From that we can surmise, if we did not know it anyway, that Goethe was no ascetic priest. He—knows more . . . 21 So far as this whole sort of priestly medication is concerned, the “guilty” sort, any word of criticism is too much. That an excess of feeling of the sort the ascetic priest habitually prescribes for his sick people in this case (under the holiest of names, as is obvious, while convinced of the sanctity of his purpose) has truly been of use to some invalid: who would really want to defend the truth of this kind of claim? At least we should come to an understanding of that phrase “been of use.” If with those words people wish to assert that such a system of treatment has improved human beings, then I won’t contradict them. I would only add what “improved” indicates to me—it’s as much as saying “tamed,” “weakened,” “disheartened,” “refined,” “mollycoddled” (hence, almost equivalent to damaged . . .). But when we are mainly concerned with sick, upset, and depressed people, such a system, even supposing that it makes them “better,” always makes them sicker. You only have to ask doctors who treat the mentally ill [Irrenärzte] what a methodical

application of the torments of repentance, remorse, and convulsions of redemption always brings with it. We should also consult history: wherever the ascetic priest has put in place this way of dealing with the sick, illness has always spread far and wide at terrifying speed. What has its “success” always involved? The person who was already ill gets in addition a shattered nervous system, and that occurs on the largest and smallest scale, among individuals and among masses of people. As a consequence of a training in repentance and redemption, we witness huge epidemics of epilepsy, the greatest known to history, as in the St. Vitus’ and St. John’s dances in the Middle Ages. We find its repercussions in other forms of fearful paralysis and enduring depression, with which, under certain circumstances, the temperament of an entire people or city (Geneva, Basel) is changed into its opposite once and for all—with these belong also the witch crazes, something related to sleep walking (eight major epidemics of this broke out between 1564 and 1605 alone);—among its consequences we also find that death-seeking mass hysteria whose horrific cry “*eviva la morte*” [long live death] was heard far across the whole of Europe, interrupted by idiosyncratic outbursts—sometimes of lust, sometimes of destructive frenzies, just as the same alternation of emotions, with the same intermissions and reversals, can also still be observed nowadays all over the place, in every case where the ascetic doctrine of sin once again enjoys a great success (religious neurosis appears as a form of an “evil nature”—that’s indisputable. What is it? *Quaeritur* [that’s what we need to ask]). Generally speaking, the ascetic ideal and its cult of moral sublimity, this supremely clever, most dubious, and most dangerous systematization of all the ways to promote an excess of emotion under the protection of holy purposes, has etched itself into the entire history of human beings in a dreadful and unforgettable manner, and, alas, not only into their history. . . . Apart from this ideal, there’s scarcely anything else I would know to point to which has had such a destructive effect on the health and racial power, particularly of Europeans. Without any exaggeration, we can call it the true disaster in the history of the health of European people. At most, the specifically German influence might be comparable to its effect: I refer to the alcohol poisoning of Europe, which up to now has marched strictly in step with the political and racial superiority of the Germans (—wherever they have infused their blood, they have also infused their vices).—The third in line would be syphilis—*magno sed proxima intervallo* [next in line, but after a large gap]. 22 Wherever he achieved mastery, the ascetic priest has ruined spiritual health. As a result, he has also ruined taste in *artibus et litteris* [in arts and letters]—he is still ruining that. “As a result”?—I hope you will simply concede me this “as a result.” At least, I have no desire to demonstrate it first. A single indication: it concerns the fundamental text of Christian literature, its essential model, its “book in itself.” Still in the middle of the Graeco-Roman magnificence, which was also a magnificent time for books,

faced with a ancient world of writing which had not yet declined and fallen apart, an age in which people could still read some books for which one would now exchange half of all literature, the simplicity and vanity of Christian agitators—we call them the church fathers—already dared to proclaim, “We also have our classical literature. We don’t need Greek literature.”—And with that, they pointed with pride to books of legends, letters of the apostles, and little apologetic treatises, in somewhat the same way as nowadays the English “Salvation Army” with its related literature fights its war against Shakespeare and other “pagans.” I don’t like the “New Testament”—you will already have guessed as much. It almost disturbs me that I stand alone in my taste with respect to this most highly regarded and most overvalued written work (the taste of two thousand years is against me). But how can I help it! “Here I stand. I can do no other”(18)—I have the courage of my own bad taste. The Old Testament—now, that’s something totally different: all honour to the Old Testament! In that I find great men, a heroic landscape, and something of the very rarest of all elements on earth, the incomparable naïveté of the strong heart; even more—I find a people. In the New Testament, by contrast, I find nothing but small sectarian households, nothing but spiritual rococo, nothing but ornament, twisty little corners, oddities, nothing but conventional air, not to mention an occasional breeze of bucolic sweet sentimentality, which belongs to the age (and the Roman province), something not so much Jewish as Hellenistic. Humility and pomposity standing shoulder to shoulder; a chatting about feelings which are almost stupefying; vehement feelings but no passion, with awkward gestures. Here, it seems, there’s a lack of all good upbringing. How can people make such a fuss about their small vices, the way these devout little men do? No cock—and certainly not God—would crow about such things. Finally, they even want to possess “the crown of eternal life,” all these small people from the provinces. But what for? What for? It is impossible to push presumption any further. An “immortal” Peter: who could endure him? They have an ambition that makes one laugh: one of them spells out his most personal things, his stupidities, melancholy, and indolent worries, as if the essence of all things had a duty to worry about such matters. Another one never gets tired of wrapping up God himself in the smallest misery he finds himself stuck in. And the most appalling taste of this constant familiarity with God! This Jewish, and not merely Jewish, excessive importuning God with mouth and paw! . . . There are small despised “pagan people” in east Asia from whom these first Christians could have learned something important, some tact in their reverence. As Christian missionaries reveal, such people are not generally allowed to utter the name of their god. This seems to me sufficiently delicate. It was certainly too delicate not only for the “first” Christians. To sense the contrast, we should remember something about Luther, the “most eloquent” and most presumptuous peasant Germany ever had,

and the tone Luther adopted as the one he most preferred in his conversations with God. Luther's resistance to the interceding saints of the church (especially to "the devil's sow, the Pope") was undoubtedly, in the last analysis, the resistance of a lout irritated by the good etiquette of the church, that etiquette of reverence of the priestly taste, which lets only the more consecrated and the more discreet into the holy of holies and shuts the door against the louts, who in this particular place are never to speak. But Luther, the peasant, simply wanted something different—this situation was not German enough for him. Above all, he wanted to speak directly, to speak for himself, to speak "openly" with his God. Well, he did it.—You can conjecture easily enough that there has never been a place anywhere in which the ascetic ideal has been a school of good taste, even less of good manners—in the best cases, it was a school for priestly manners. That comes about because it carries something in its own body which is the deadly enemy of all good manners—it lacks moderation, it resists moderation, it is itself a "non plus ultra" [an ultimate extreme].²³ The ascetic ideal has not only ruined health and taste; it has also ruined a third, fourth, fifth, and sixth something as well—I'll be careful not to mention everything (when would I come to the end!). I'm not going to reveal what this ideal has brought about. I would much rather confine myself to what it means, what it allows us to surmise, what lies hidden behind, under, and in it, what it provisionally and indistinctly expresses, overloaded with question marks and misunderstandings. And only with this purpose in mind, I cannot spare my readers a glimpse into the monstrosity of its effects, as well as its disastrous consequences, in order, that is, to prepare them for the ultimate and most terrifying aspects which the question of the meaning of this ideal has for me. Just what does the power of this ideal mean, the monstrous nature of this power? Why was it given room to grow to this extent? Why was there not a more effective resistance? The ascetic ideal is the expression of a will. Where is the opposing will, in which an opposing ideal finds its expression? The ascetic ideal has a goal—a goal which is universal enough that all other interests in human existence, measured against it, seem small and narrow. It interprets times, people, and humanity unsparingly with this goal in mind. It permits no other interpretation. No other goal counts. It rejects, denies, affirms, and confirms only through its own interpretative meaning (—and has there ever been a system of interpretation more thoroughly thought through?); it does not submit to any power; by contrast, it believes in its privileged position in relation to all power, in its absolutely higher ranking with respect to every power—it believes that there is no power on earth which does not have to derive its meaning first from it, a right to exist, a value, as a tool in its own work, as a way and a means to its own goal, to a single goal. . . . Where is the counterpart to this closed system of will, goal, and interpretation? Why is this counterpart missing? . . . Where is the other "single goal"? But people tell me

that counterpart is not missing, claiming it has not only fought a long and successful war with that ideal, but has already mastered that ideal on all major points: all our modern science is a testament to that—this modern science, which, as a true philosophy of reality, evidently believes only in itself, evidently possesses courage and will in itself, and has got along up to this point well enough without God, a world beyond, and virtues which deny. However, I'm not impressed at all with such a fuss and chattering from agitators: these trumpeters of reality are bad musicians. One can hear well enough that their notes do not sound out of the depths. The abyss of scientific conscience does not speak through them—for today the scientific conscience is an abyss—the phrase “science” in such trumpeting mouths is mere fornication, an abuse, an indecency. The truth is precisely the opposite of what is claimed here: science nowadays has simply no faith in itself, to say nothing of an ideal above it—and where it consists at all of passion, love, ardour, suffering, that doesn't make it the opposite of that ascetic ideal but rather its newest and most pre-eminent form. Does that sound strange to you? . . . There are indeed a sufficient number of upright and modest working people among scholars nowadays, happy in their little corners, and because their work satisfies them, they make noises from time to time, demanding, with some presumption, that people today should in general be happy, particularly with science—there are so many useful things to do precisely there. I don't deny that. The last thing I want to do is to ruin the pleasure these honest labourers take in the tasks they perform. For I'm happy about their work. But the fact that people are working rigorously in science these days and that there are satisfied workers is simply no proof that science today, as a totality, has a goal, a will, an ideal, a passion in a great faith. As I've said, the opposite is the case: where science is not the most recently appearing form of the ascetic ideal—and then it's a matter of cases too rare, noble, and exceptional to be capable of countering the general judgment—science today is a hiding place for all kinds of unhappiness, disbelief, gnawing worms, *despectio sui* [self-contempt], bad conscience—it is the anxiety of the very absence of ideals, suffering from the lack of a great love, the dissatisfaction with a condition of involuntary modest content. O, what nowadays does science not conceal! How much, at least, it is meant to conceal! The efficiency of our best scholars, their mindless diligence, their heads smoking day and night, the very mastery of their handiwork—how often has all that really derived its meaning from the fact that they don't permit some things to become visible to them any more! Science as a means of putting themselves to sleep. Are you acquainted with that? . . . People wound scholars to the bone—everyone who associates with them experiences this—sometimes with a harmless word. We make our scholarly friends angry with us when we intend to honour them. We drive them wild, merely because we were too coarse to figure out the people we are truly dealing with, suffering people, who don't wish to

admit to themselves what they are, narcotised and mindless people, who fear only one thing—coming to consciousness. 24 Now, let's consider, on the other hand, those rarer cases I mentioned, the last idealists remaining today among the philosophers and scholars. Perhaps in them we have the opponents of the ascetic ideal we're looking for, the counter-idealists? In fact, that's what they think they are, these "unbelievers" (for that's what they are collectively). That, in particular, seems to be their last item of belief, that they are opponents of this ideal, for they are so serious about this stance, their words and gestures are so passionate on this very point:—but is it therefore necessarily the case that what they believe is true? We "knowledgeable people" are positively suspicious of all forms of believers. Our suspicion has gradually cultivated the habit in us of concluding the reverse of what people previously concluded: that is, wherever the strength of a faith steps decisively into the foreground, we infer a certain weakness in its ability to demonstrate its truth, even the improbability of what it believes. We, too, do not deny that the belief "makes blessed," but for that very reason we deny that the belief proves something—a strong belief which confers blessedness creates doubts about what it has faith in. It does not ground "truth." It grounds a certain probability—delusion. Well, how do things stand in this case?—These people who say no today, these outsiders, these people who are determined on one point, their demand for intellectual probity, these hard, strong, abstemious, heroic spirits, who constitute the honour of our age, all these pale atheists, anti-Christians, immoralists, nihilists, these sceptics, ephectics, hectics of the spirit (collectively they are all hectic in some sense or other), the last idealists of knowledge, the only ones in whom intellectual conscience lives and takes on human form nowadays—they really do believe that they are as free as possible from the ascetic ideal, these "free, very free spirits," and yet I am revealing to them what they cannot see for themselves—for they are standing too close to themselves—this ascetic ideal is also their very own ideal. They themselves represent it today. Perhaps they are the only ones who do. They themselves are its most spiritual offspring, the furthest advanced of its troops and its crowd of scouts, its most awkward, most delicate, most incomprehensibly seductive form. If I am any kind of solver of puzzles, then I want to be that with this statement! . . . They are not free spirits—not by any stretch—for they still believe in the truth. When the Christian crusaders in the Orient came across that unconquerable Order of Assassins, that free-spirited order par excellence, whose lowest ranks lived a life of obedience of the sort no order of monks attained, then they also received by some means or other a hint about that symbol and slogan which was reserved for only the highest ranks as their secret, "Nothing is true. Everything is permitted." . . . Well now, that was freedom of the spirit. With that the very belief in truth was cancelled. . . . Has a European, a Christian free spirit ever wandered by mistake into this proposition and its labyrinthine

consequences? Has he come to know the Minotaur of this cavern from experience? . . . I doubt it. More than that: I know differently:— nothing is more immediately foreign to people set on one thing, these so-called “free spirits,” than freedom and emancipation in this sense: in no respect are they more firmly bound; in their very belief in the truth they are, as no one else is, firm and unconditional. Perhaps I understand all this from far too close a distance: that admirable philosophical abstinence which such a belief requires, that intellectual stoicism, which ultimately forbids one to deny just as strongly as it forbids one to affirm, that desire to come to a standstill before the facts, the *factum brutum* [brute fact], that fatalism of the “*petits faits*” [small facts] (what I call *ce petit fatalisme* [this small factism]), that quality with which French science nowadays seeks a sort of moral precedence over German science, the attainment of a state where one, in general, abandons interpretation (violating, emending, abbreviating, letting go, filling in the cracks, composing, forging, and the other actions which belong to the nature of all interpretation)—generally speaking, this attitude expresses just as much virtuous asceticism as any denial of sensuality (basically it is only one mode of this denial). However, what compels a person to this unconditional will for truth is the faith in the ascetic ideal itself, even though it may be its unconscious imperative. We should not deceive ourselves on this point—it is a belief in a metaphysical value, a value of truth in itself, something guaranteed and affirmed only in that ideal (it stands or falls with that ideal). Strictly speaking, there is no science “without presuppositions.” The idea of such a science is unimaginable, paralogical: a philosophy, a “belief,” must always be there first, so that with it science can have a direction, a sense, a border, a method, a right to exist. (Whoever thinks the reverse, whoever, for example, is preparing to place philosophy “on a strictly scientific foundation,” first must place, not just philosophy, but also truth itself on its head—the worst injury to decency one could possibly give to two such venerable women!). In fact, there is no doubt about this matter—and here I’m letting my book *The Gay Science* have a word (see its fifth book, Section 344)—“The truthful person, in that daring and ultimate sense which the belief in science presupposes in him, thus affirms a world different from the world of life, of nature, and of history, and to the extent that he affirms this “other world,” well? Must he not in the process deny its opposite, this world, our world? . . . Our faith in science rests on something which is still a metaphysical belief—even we knowledgeable people of today, we godless and anti-metaphysical people—we, too, still take our fire from that blaze kindled by a thousand years of old belief, that faith in Christianity, which was also Plato’s belief, that God is the truth, that the truth is divine. . . . But how can we do that, if this very claim is constantly getting more and more difficult to believe, if nothing reveals itself as divine any more, unless it’s error, blindness, lies—if even God manifests himself as our longest lasting lie?” At this point it’s

necessary to pause and reflect for a long while. Science itself from now on requires some justification (by that I don't yet mean to claim that there is such a justification for it). People should examine the oldest and the most recent philosophers on this question. They all lack an awareness of the problem of the extent to which the will to truth itself first needs some justification—here is a hole in every philosophy. How does that come about? It's because the ascetic ideal up to this point has been master of all philosophies, because truth has been established as being, as god, as the highest authority itself, because truth was not allowed to be problematic. Do you understand this “allowed”?—From the moment when the belief in the god of the ascetic ideal is denied, there is also a new problem: the problem of the value of truth.—The will to truth requires a critique—let us identify our own work with that requirement—for once to place in question, as an experiment, the value of truth. . . . (Anyone who thinks this has been stated too briefly is urged to read over that section of *The Gay Science*, pp. 160 ff, which carries the title “The Extent to Which We Also Are Still Devout,” Section 344—or better, the entire fifth book of that work, as well as the preface to *(The Dawn.)* 25 No! People should not come at me with science when I am looking for the natural antagonist of the ascetic ideal, when I ask, “Where is the opposing will, in which an opposing ideal expresses itself?” For that purpose, science does not stand sufficiently on its own, not nearly; for that it first requires an value ideal, a power to make value, in whose service it could have faith in itself—science is never in itself something which creates values. Its relationship to the ascetic ideal is still not inherently antagonistic at all. It's even more that case that, for the most part, it represents the forward-driving force in the inner development of this ideal. Its resistance and struggle, when we inspect more closely, are not concerned in any way with the ideal itself, but only with its external trappings, clothing, masquerade, its temporary hardening, petrification, dogma. Science makes the life in this ideal free again, since it denies what is exoteric in it. These two things, science and the ascetic ideal—they really stand on a single foundation—I've just clarified the point—namely, on the same overvaluing of the truth (or more correctly, on the same faith in the inestimable value of the truth, which is beyond criticism). In that very claim they are necessarily allies—so that, if someone is going to fight against them, he can only fight them together and place them both in question. An appraisal of the value of the ascetic ideal unavoidably also involves an appraisal of the value of science; while there's still time people should to keep their eyes open for that, their ears alert! (As for art—let me offer a preliminary remark, for I'll be coming back to it at some point or other at greater length—the very art in which the lie sanctifies itself and the will to deceive has good conscience on its side is much more fundamentally opposed to the ascetic ideal than is science: that's what Plato's instinct experienced—the greatest enemy of art which Europe has produced up to

this point. Plato versus Homer: that's the entire, the true antagonism—on one side, the “beyond” of the best will, the great slanderer of life; on the other side, life's unintentional worshipper, the golden nature. An artistic bondage in the service of the ascetic ideal is thus the truest corruption of the artist there can be. Unfortunately it's one of the most common, for nothing is more corruptible than an artist.) Physiologically considered, science also rests on the same foundation as the ascetic ideal: a certain impoverishment of life is the precondition for both—emotions become cool, the tempo slows down, dialectic replaces instinct, seriousness stamped on faces and gestures (seriousness, this most unmistakable sign of a more laborious metabolism, of a life of struggle and hard work). Just look at those periods in a population when the scholars step up into the foreground: they are times of exhaustion, often of evening, of decline. The overflowing force, the certainty about life, the certainty about the future have gone. The preponderance of mandarins never indicates anything good—no more than does the arrival of democracy, the peace tribunal instead of war, equal rights for women, the religion of pity, and all the other things symptomatic of a degenerating life. (Science grasped as a problem: what does science mean?—on this point see the Preface to *The Birth of Tragedy*).—No! This “modern science”—keep your eyes open for this—is for the time being the best ally of the ascetic ideal, and precisely for this reason: because it is the most unconscious, the most involuntary, the most secret and most subterranean ally! They have up to now been playing a single game, the “poor in spirit” and the scientific opponents of that ideal (we should be careful, incidentally, not to think that these opponents are the opposite of that ideal, something like the rich in spirit—that they are not; I call them hectics of the spirit). The famous victories of the latter—and they have undoubtedly been victories—but over what? They in no way overcame the ascetic ideal. With those victories, the ideal instead became stronger, that is, harder to understand, more spiritual, more dangerous, as science ruthlessly and continually kept breaking off and demolishing a wall, an external structure which had built itself onto the ideal and coarsened its appearance. Do people really think that, for example, the downfall of theological astronomy indicates a downfall of that ideal? . . . Because of that, have human beings perhaps become less dependent on redemption in a world beyond as a solution for the puzzle of their existence, given that existence since then looks, in the visible order of things, even more arbitrary, indolent, and dispensable? Isn't it the case that since Copernicus the very self-diminution of human beings, their will to self-diminution, has made inexorable progress?(19) Alas, the faith in their dignity, uniqueness, irreplaceable position in the chain of being has gone—the human being has become an animal, not a metaphorical animal, but absolutely and unconditionally—the one who in his earlier faith was almost God (“child of God,” “God-man” [Gottmensch]) . . . Since Copernicus human beings seem to

have reached an inclined plane—they're now rolling at an accelerating rate past the mid-point—where to? Into nothingness? Into the “penetrating sense of their own nothingness”? . . . Well, then, wouldn't this be precisely the way—into the old ideal? . . . All science (and not just astronomy, about whose humbling and destructive effects Kant made a noteworthy confession, “it destroys my importance”. . .)—all science, natural as well as unnatural—the name I give to the self-criticism of knowledge—is nowadays keen to talk human beings out of the respect they used to have for themselves, as if the latter were nothing more than a bizarre arrogance about themselves. In this matter we could even say science has its own pride, its characteristically acrid form of stoical ataraxia [indifference], in maintaining this laboriously attained self-contempt for human beings as their ultimate, most serious demand for self respect (and, in fact, that's justified, for the one who despises is still one person who “has not forgotten respect” . . .). Does doing this really work against the ascetic ideal? Do people really think in all seriousness (as the theologians imagined for quite a while) that, say, Kant's victory over dogmatic theological concepts (“God,” “Soul,” “Freedom,” “Immortality”) succeeded in breaking up that ideal?—in asking that question, it should not concern us at the moment whether Kant himself had anything at all like that in mind. What is certain is that all sorts of transcendentalists since Kant have once more won the game—they've been emancipated from the theologians. What a stroke of luck!—Kant showed them that secret path by which from now on they could, on their own initiative and with the finest scientific decency, follow their “hearts' desires.” Similarly who could now hold anything against the agnostics, if they, as admirers of what is inherently unknown and secret, worship the question mark itself as their God? (Xaver Doudan once spoke of the ravages brought on by “l'habitude d'admirer l'inintelligible au lieu de rester tout simplement dans l'inconnu” [the habit of admiring the unintelligible instead of simply staying in the unknown]; he claimed that the ancients had not done this).(20) If everything human beings “know” does not satisfy their wishes and, instead, contradicts them and makes them shudder, what a divine excuse to be allowed to seek the blame for this not in “wishes” but in “knowledge”! . . . “There is no knowledge. Consequently—there is a God”—what a new *elegantia syllogismi* [syllogistic excellence]! What a triumph of the ascetic ideal! 26 Or does modern historical writing collectively perhaps display an attitude more confident about life, more confident about ideals? Its noblest claim nowadays asserts that it is a mirror. It eschews all teleology. It doesn't want to “prove” anything any more. It spurns playing the role of judge and derives its good taste from that—it affirms as little as it denies. It establishes the facts. It “describes” . . . All this is ascetic to a high degree. However, it is also, to an even higher degree, nihilistic. We must not deceive ourselves on this point. We see a sad, hard, but determined gaze—an eye which looks into the distance, the way a

solitary traveller at the North Pole gazes out (perhaps so as not to look inside? not to look behind? . . .) Here is snow; here life is quite silent. The final crows that make noise here are called “what for?” “in vain,” “nada” [nothing]—here nothing thrives and grows any more, at most Petersburg metapolitics and Tolstoian “pity.” But so far as that other style of historian is concerned, maybe an even “more modern” style, which is comfortable and sensual and makes eyes at life as much as at the ascetic ideal—this style uses the word “artist” as a glove and has taken an exclusive lease on the praise of contemplation. O what a thirst these sweet and witty types arouse in people even for ascetics and winter landscapes! No! Let the devil take these “meditative” people! I would much prefer to keep wandering with those historical nihilists through the gloomiest cold gray fog!—In fact, if I had to choose, I might find it better to lend a ear to a completely and essentially unhistorical or anti-historical man (like that Dühring, whose tones intoxicate a species of “beautiful souls” in Germany today, people who up to now have been a still timid, still unassuming species, the species anarchistica [the anarchists] within the educated proletariat). The “contemplative ones” are a hundred times worse—: I know nothing that creates so much disgust as such an objective armchair, such a sweet-smelling man luxuriating in history, half cleric, half satyr, with perfume by Renan, who reveals at once in the high falsetto of his approval what he lacks, where is he deficient, where in his case the Fates have wielded their dreadful shears with, alas, so much surgical precision! (21) That affronts my taste as well as my patience: confronted with such sights, let those be patient who have nothing to lose by them—such a picture infuriates me, such “lookers on” make me angry with the “spectacle,” even more than the spectacle itself (history itself, you understand). Seeing that, I fall unexpectedly into an Anacreontic mood. This nature, which gave the bull his horns, the lion his chasmodonton [chasm of teeth], why did nature give me a foot? . . . To kick with—by holy Anacreon!(22)—and not merely to run off, but to kick apart these decrepit armchairs, this cowardly contemplation, this lascivious acting like eunuchs in front of history, the flirting with ascetic ideals, the Tartufferie [hypocrisy] in the justice of impotence! I grant all honour to the ascetic ideal, insofar as it is honest! So long as it believes in itself and does not play games with us! But I can’t stand all these coquettish insects, with their insatiable ambition to sniff out the infinite, until finally the infinite stinks of bugs. I can’t stand these white sepulchres who treat life as play acting. I can’t stand the tired and useless people, who wrap themselves up in wisdom and gaze out “objectively.” I can’t stand the agitators who dress themselves up as heroes, who wear a magic hat of ideals on heads stuffed with straw. I can’t stand the ambitious artists, who like to present themselves as ascetics and priests, but who are basically tragic clowns. And I can’t stand these most recent speculators in idealism, the anti-Semites, who nowadays roll their eyes around in a Christian-

Aryan-Bourgeois way and seek to inflame all the horned-animal elements among the people by abusing the cheapest form of agitation, moral posturing, in a way that exhausts all my patience (—the fact that every kind of spiritual fraud succeeds in present-day Germany is the result of the absolutely undeniable and already tangible desolation of the German spirit, whose cause I look for in an excessively strict diet limited to newspapers, politics, beer, and Wagnerian music, together with the pre-condition for such a diet: first, a restricting nationalism and vanity, that strong but narrow principle “Germany, Germany, over everything,” as well as the paralysis agitans [trembling palsy] of “modern ideas”).(23) Today Europe is rich and resourceful, above all, in ways of arousing people. Nothing seems to be more important to possess than stimulants and firewater: hence, the monstrous falsification of ideals, the most powerful firewater of the spirit. Hence also the unfavourable, stinking, lying, pseudo-alcoholic air everywhere. I’d like to know how many shiploads of counterfeit idealism, of heroic costumes and rattles full of nonsensical big words, how many tons of sugary spiritual sympathy (its business name: *la religion de la souffrance* [the religion of suffering]), how many stilts of “noble indignation” to assist the spiritually flat-footed, and how many play actors of the Christian moral ideal would have to be exported from Europe today so that its air might smell cleaner once again. . . . Obviously, as far as this overproduction is concerned, a new commercial possibility has opened up: obviously there is new “business” to be made with small gods of ideals and their accompanying “idealists”—people should not fail to hear this hint! Who has the courage for it? We have it in our hands to “idealize” the entire earth! . . . But why am I talking about courage? Only one thing is necessary here, just the hand, an uninhibited, a very uninhibited hand.— 27 Enough! Enough! Let’s leave these curiosities and complexities of the most modern spirit, which inspire as much laughter as irritation. Our problem can do without them, the problem of the meaning of the ascetic ideal. What has that to do with yesterday and today! I am going to approach these issues more fundamentally and more forcefully in another connection (under the title *On The History of European Nihilism*. I refer to a work which I am preparing: *The Will to Power: An Attempt To Re-evaluate all Values*). What I have been dealing with here is only the following—to establish that the ascetic ideal has, for the time being, even in the most spiritual sphere, only one kind of true enemy who can inflict harm, and that enemy is those who play-act this ideal—for they awaken distrust. Everywhere else, where the spirit nowadays is strong, powerful, and working without counterfeiting, it generally dispenses with the ideal—the popular expression for this abstinence is “atheism,” except for its will to truth. But this will, this remnant of the ideal is, if people wish to believe me, that very ideal in its strongest, most spiritual formulation, thoroughly esoteric, stripped of all its outer structures, and thus not so much a remnant, as its kernel. Consequently, absolutely unconditional atheism

(—and that’s the only air we breathe, we more spiritual men of this age!) does not stand opposed to this ideal, as it appears to do. It is much rather only one of its last stages of development, one of its concluding forms and innerly logical outcomes. It demands reverence, this catastrophe of two thousand years of breeding for the truth which concludes by forbidding itself the lie of a faith in God. (The same process of development in India, which was fully independent of Europe and therefore proof of something—this same ideal forced things to a similar conclusion. The decisive point was reached five centuries before the European calendar, with Buddha, or more precisely, with the Sankhya philosophy. For this was popularized by Buddha and made into a religion.) Putting the question as forcefully as possible, what really triumphed over the Christian God? The answer stands in my *Gay Science*, p. 290: “Christian morality itself, the increasingly strict understanding of the idea of truthfulness, the subtlety of the father confessor of the Christian conscience, transposed and sublimated into scientific conscience, into intellectual cleanliness at any price. To look at nature as if it were a proof of the goodness and care of a god, to interpret history in such a way as to honour divine reason, as a constant testament to a moral world order and moral intentions, to interpret one’s own experiences, as devout men have interpreted them for long enough, as if everything was divine providence, everything was a sign, everything was thought out and sent for the salvation of the soul out of love—now that’s over and done with. That has conscience against it. Among more sensitive consciences that counts as something indecent, dishonest, as lying, feminism, weakness, cowardice. With this rigour, if with anything, we are good Europeans and heirs to Europe’s longest and bravest overcoming of the self. All great things destroy themselves by an act of self-cancellation. That’s what the law of life wills, that law of the necessary “self-overcoming” in the essence of life—eventually the call always goes out to the lawmaker himself, “patere legem, quam ipse tulisti” [submit to the law which you yourself have established]. That’s the way Christianity was destroyed as dogma by its own morality; that’s the way Christendom as morality must now also be destroyed. We stand on the threshold of this event. After Christian truthfulness has come to a series of conclusions, it will draw its strongest conclusion, its conclusion against itself. However, this will occur when it poses the question: “What is the meaning of all will to truth?” Here I move back again to my problem, to our problem, my unknown friends (—for I still don’t know anything about friends): what sense would our whole being have if not for the fact that in us that will to truth became aware of itself as a problem? . . . Because this will to truth from now on is growing conscious of itself, morality from now on is dying—there’s no doubt about that. That great spectacle in one hundred acts, which remains reserved for the next two centuries in Europe, that most fearful, most questionable, and perhaps also most hopeful of

all spectacles . . . 28 If we leave aside the ascetic ideal, then man, the animal man, has had no meaning up to this point. His existence on earth has had no purpose. “Why man at all?” was a question without an answer. The will for man and earth was missing. Behind every great human destiny echoes as refrain an even greater “in vain” That is just what the ascetic ideal means: that something is missing, that a huge hole surrounds man—he did not know how to justify himself to himself, to explain, to affirm; he suffered from the problem of his meaning. He also suffered in other ways as well: he was for the most part a pathological animal, but the suffering itself was not his problem, rather the fact that he lacked an answer to the question he screamed out, “Why this suffering?” Man, the bravest animal, the one most accustomed to suffering, does not deny suffering in itself; he desires it; he seeks it out in person, provided that people show him a meaning for it, a purpose of suffering. The curse that earlier spread itself over men was not suffering, but the senselessness of suffering—and the ascetic ideal offered him a meaning! The ascetic ideal has been the only meaning offered up to this point. Any meaning is better than no meaning at all; however one looks at it, the ascetic ideal has so far been the “faute de mieux” [for lack of something better] *par excellence*. In it suffering was interpreted, the huge hole appeared filled in, the door shut against all suicidal nihilism. The interpretation undoubtedly brought new suffering with it—more profound, more inner, more poisonous, and more life-gnawing suffering; it brought all suffering under the perspective of guilt. . . . But nevertheless—with it man was saved. He had a meaning; from that point on he was no longer like a leaf in the wind, a toy ball of nonsense, of “without sense”; he could now will something—at first it didn’t matter where, why, or how he willed: the will itself was saved. We simply cannot conceal from ourselves what is really expressed by that total will which received its direction from the ascetic ideal: this hate against what is human, even more against animality, even more against material things—this abhorrence of the senses, of reason itself, this fear of happiness and beauty, this longing for the beyond away from all appearance, change, becoming, death, desire, even longing itself—all this means, let’s have the courage to understand this, a will to nothingness, an aversion to life, a revolt against the most fundamental preconditions of life—but it is and remains a will! . . . And to finish up by repeating what I said at the beginning: man will sooner will nothingness than not will

ENDNOTES (1) Thus Spoke Zarathustra: a work written by Nietzsche between 1883 and 1885. [Back to Text] (2) Luther: Martin Luther (1483-1546), German monk and university professor whose revolutionary break with the Catholic Church launched the Reformation; Die Meistersinger: The Mastersingers of Nuremburg, an opera by Richard Wagner, first performed in 1868. [Back to Text] (3) Parsifal: the hero of Wagner’s opera of the same name, first performed in 1882. [Back to Text] (4) Schopenhauer: Arthur Schopenhauer

(1788-1860), influential German philosopher, whose work emphasized the importance of the Will. [Back to Text] (5) Stendhal: pen name of Marie-Henri Beyle (1783-1842), a French novelist whom Nietzsche admired for his psychological acuity. [Back to Text] (6) Pygmalion: In classical mythology a sculptor who carved a woman so lifelike and beautiful, that he fell in love with it. [Back to Text] (7) Ixion: In Greek mythology a mortal man who tried to seduce Zeus' wife, Hera, and was punished in Hades by being bound on a fiery wheel which was always spinning. [Back to Text] (8) The Latin here is a reworking of the famous legal saying "Fiat Justitia et pereat mundus" [Let justice be done, though the world perish]. The saying is attributed to Ferdinand I (1503-1564), the Holy Roman Emperor, who adopted it as his motto. [Back to Text] (9) Piazza San Marco: the main city square in Venice. [Back to Text] (10) . . . resentment: Nietzsche introduces this important term in the First Essay of Genealogy of Morals, in Section 10: a short definition is as follows: "deep-seated resentment, frustration, and hostility, accompanied by a sense of being powerless to express these feelings directly" (Merriam-Webster). [Back to Text] (11) . . . Eugene Dühring (1833-1921), a German philosopher and socialist who attacked Marxism, Christianity, and Judaism. [Back to Text] (12) The reference to Shakespeare's Squire Christopher [Junker Christoph] may be (as Walter Kaufmann suggests) an allusion to *The Taming of the Shrew*, where the hero, Petruchio refers to a vegetarian diet (see Kaufmann's translation of *Genealogy of Morals*, 131); or it may be (as Maudemarie Clark and Alan J. Swensen propose) an allusion to *Twelfth Night*, where Sir Andrew Aguecheek (called Junker Christoph in one German translation of the play) comments on his eating habits. See the Clark and Swensen translation of *Genealogy of Morality*, 156. Nietzsche refers to Junker Christoph's meat-eating habits again later on in this section. The Thirty Years War (1618-1648) was a disastrous European conflict which began as a fight over religion. [Back to Text] (13) Hesychasts: a religious tradition in the Eastern Orthodox Church which emphasizes an inner spiritual retreat and abandonment of sense experience. St Theresa (1515-1582), a famous Spanish mystic. [Back to Text] (14) Shankara (788?-820), Indian philosopher who played a formative role in the historical development of Hinduism. Paul Deussen (1845-1919), an important German scholar of Indian religion. [Back to Text] (15) Geulincx: Arnold Geulincx (1624-1669), a Flemish philosopher. [Back to Text] (16) Thomas Moore (1779-1852), an Irish poet; Dr. Gwinner: Wilhelm von Gwinner (1825-1917), German lawyer and civil servant. Thayer: Alexander Thayer (1817-1897). [Back to Text] (17) Taine: Hippolyte Adolphe Taine (1828-1893), a French historian; Leopold Ranke: (1795 to 1886) a very famous and influential German historian. [Back to Text] (18) . . . no other: This is one of Martin Luther's most famous quotations, allegedly his reply when asked to take back his criticisms of the church, a response which launched the Reformation in

1521. [Back to Text] (19) Copernicus: Nicolaus Copernicus (1473-1543), the Polish astronomer and monk who produced a scientifically based theory of a sun-centred solar system. [Back to Text] (20) Xaver Doudan: Ximénès Doudan (1800-1872), a French writer. [Back to Text] (21) Renan: Ernest Renan (1823-1892), French writer and philosopher, particularly famous for his *Life of Jesus*. [Back to Text] (22) Anacreon: (born c. 570 BC), Greek lyric poet famous for his drinking songs. [Back to Text] (23) “Germany, Germany, over everything”: the opening lines of the German national anthem “Deutschland, Deutschland, über alles”; the lyrics were written in 1841 to music by Haydn. The song was adopted as the national anthem in 1922. [Back to Text] [Link to Genealogy of Morals](#), [Table of Contents](#)

Part IX

Twilight of the Idols

1888 — Translated by R.J. Hollingdale

TWILIGHT OF THE IDOLS and THE ANTI-CHRIST FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE was born near Leipzig in 1844, the son of a Lutheran clergyman. He attended the famous Pforta School, then went to university at Bonn and at Leipzig, where he studied philology and read Schopenhauer. When he was only twenty-four he was appointed to the chair of classical philology at Basle University; he stayed there until his health forced him into retirement in 1879. While at Basle he made and broke his friendship with Wagner, participated as an ambulance orderly in the Franco-Prussian War, and published *The Birth of Tragedy* (1872), *Untimely Meditations* (1873–6) and the first part of *Human, All Too Human* (1878; two supplements entitled *Assorted Opinions and Maxims* and *The Wanderer and his Shadow* followed in 1879 and 1880 respectively). From 1880 until his final collapse in 1889, except for brief interludes, he divorced himself from everyday life and, supported by his university pension, he lived mainly in France, Italy and Switzerland. *The Dawn* appeared in 1881 followed by *The Gay Science* in the autumn of 1882. Thus *Spoke Zarathustra* was written between 1883 and 1885, and his last completed books were *Ecce Homo*, an autobiography, and *Nietzsche contra Wagner*. He became insane in 1889 and remained in a condition of mental and physical paralysis until his death in 1900. MICHAEL TANNER was educated in the RAF and at Cambridge University, where he was a Lecturer in Philosophy until 1997 and is a Fellow of Corpus Christi College. He is equally interested in philosophy, music and literature, his particular areas being Friedrich Nietzsche and Richard Wagner. He has written for many journals, contributed ‘The Total Work of Art’ to *The Wagner Companion*, and is the author of *Nietzsche* (1995) and *Wagner* (1996). R. J. HOLLINGDALE translated eleven of Nietzsche’s books and published two books about him; he also translated works by, among others, Schopenhauer, Goethe, E. T. A. Hoffman, Lichtenberg and Theodor Fontane, many of these for Penguin Classics. He was the honorary president of the British Nietzsche Society. R. J. Hollingdale died on 28 September 2001. In its obituary *The Times* described him as ‘Britain’s foremost postwar Nietzsche specialist’ and the *Guardian* paid tribute to his ‘inspired gift for German translation’. Richard Gott

wrote that he 'brought fresh generations – through fluent and intelligent translation – to read and relish Nietzsche's inestimable thought'. FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE TWILIGHT OF THE IDOLS AND

Part IX (continued)

The Antichrist

1888 — Translated by R.J. Hollingdale

THE ANTI-CHRIST TRANSLATED BY R. J. HOLLINGDALE
INTRODUCTION BY MICHAEL TANNER PENGUIN BOOKS PENGUIN
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Introduction to TWILIGHT OF THE IDOLS and THE ANTI-CHRIST Both
these two brief, marvellous books were written during the latter half of 1888, the
last year of Friedrich Nietzsche's sane life. In *Ecce Homo*, the highly eccentric
autobiography which he immediately went on to write after *The Anti-Christ*,

Nietzsche remarks at the end of the short chapter he devotes to Twilight, 'I have never experienced such an autumn, nor have I thought anything of the sort possible on earth – a Claude Lorraine thought on to infinity, every day of the same excessive perfection.' In the epigraph to *Ecce Homo*, which he wrote himself, the note he strikes is still more elegiac: On this perfect day, when everything has become ripe and not only the grapes are growing brown, a ray of sunlight has fallen on to my life... The first book of the Revaluation of all Values [by which Nietzsche means *The Anti-Christ*], the Songs of Zarathustra... my attempt to philosophize with a hammer [an allusion to the subtitle of Twilight] – all of them gifts of this year, of its last quarter even! How should I not be grateful to my whole life? To move from those expressions of gratitude to the two prose works they refer to comes as a shock. For the tone of both Twilight and *The Anti-Christ* is predominantly strident, even shrill, and many commentators, not just unsympathetic ones, have registered distress at what strikes them as a self-betraying crudity and oversimplification of the profound and somewhat more calmly expressed insights to be found in his preceding books, especially in *On the Genealogy of Morals* written only the previous year. Nietzsche's self-apotheosis in *Ecce Homo* and his collapse into insanity at the very beginning of 1889 are taken by these regretful readers as sad confirmations of the deterioration discernible in these two soi-distant autumnal products. Yet if one recognizes the irony of *Ecce Homo* and if one didn't know of Nietzsche's impending madness, the difference of tone between these two books and what preceded them might well not seem so great, and the incredible richness of content which both of them possess might be more apparent. It would be grotesque, of course, to deny that these books are, to put it at its gentlest, eccentric. The arch Yes-sayer seems to be on remarkably negative form, as both titles suggest. He even seems to be unclear on this matter himself. In number 6 of the section of Twilight entitled 'What the Germans Lack' he says, 'To be true to my nature, which is affirmative and has dealings with contradiction and criticism only indirectly and when compelled...', while in number 1 of the last section, 'What I Owe to the Ancients', he writes, rather more convincingly until the last clause, 'My taste, which may be called the opposite of a tolerant taste, is... far from uttering a wholesale Yes: in general it dislikes saying Yes, it would rather say No, most of all it prefers to say nothing at all', and in the Foreword he claims that 'This little book is a grand declaration of war', having just written – to confuse the issue still further – that 'This book... is above all a relaxation, a sunspot, an escapade into the idle hours of a psychologist.' It would perhaps be tactless, and giving hostages to fortune, to press Nietzsche too hard about this; but it is strange that a book which claims to demolish 'Not merely eternal idols, also the youngest of all' (his characterization of it in *Ecce Homo*) should saunter into the world as 'a relaxation', etc. And yet their apparent contradictoriness is

also typical of both these books and does force the question of whether Nietzsche was losing his grip or, more interestingly and alarmingly, whether *Twilight*, which presents itself as a lightning tour of his whole philosophy, doesn't inadvertently serve the purpose of revealing 'tensions' (the charitable word used by kindly philosophical commentators) that had all along been implicit in his thought. Nietzsche is regularly rebuked by writers who strangely feel that consistency is the most important philosophical virtue, or at least the *sine qua non* of a philosopher's deserving to be taken seriously, for his frequent vacillations between injunctions to lightheartedness and dire prophecies of impending gloom, between enjoining us to delight in surfaces and insisting that we plumb previously uncharted depths. If he had philosophized with less of himself than he did, such charges would be justified. But one has to ask how anyone who threw himself with such completeness into his work as Nietzsche did, could possibly have neglected to register as forcefully as he was able – which in his case means utterly – both the attractions of insouciance and those of fanatical seriousness. If he had been an artist – wholly an artist, instead of an artist-philosopher – he would have been spared this criticism. No one blames Richard Wagner for moving straight on to *Die Meistersinger* from *Tristan and Isolde*, except those who blame him for writing either. The obvious retort to that, that an artist has the right to switch from a tragic to a comic mode, and a strikingly different world view, while a philosopher doesn't, begs the question in the most spectacular way, certainly where Nietzsche is concerned. But this may seem unduly permissive. Is Nietzsche a Yes-sayer, or would he rather say No? The answer is, I think, that at the deepest level even he (whom Freud described as the person who knew more about himself than anyone else ever had or ever would) didn't know, or couldn't make up his mind. Rightly he saw various fundamental attitudes to life as warring temptations, and was unexampled in his honesty in spelling out the reasons for and against adopting any of them. And as his feelings about life accelerated in their alternations and became ever more intense, he produced in the works under consideration the two greatest documents of basic ambivalence that we possess. Very early on in *Twilight* a striking example of Nietzsche's apparently casual contradictoriness occurs. Number 12 of the Maxims and Arrows reads, 'If we possess our why of life we can put up with almost any how. – Man does not strive after happiness; only the Englishman does that.' (This may also seem typical of *Twilight* in combining a profound maxim with a cheap arrow, until we realize the place that the unfortunate English have in Nietzsche's by now highly schematized demonology, which I shall be investigating later.) The last maxim of this part states, 'Formula of my happiness: a Yes, a No, a straight line, a goal...', while number 33 reads in part, 'How little is needed for happiness! The note of a bagpipe. – Without music life would be a mistake.' If Nietzsche is so scornful of searching after happiness,

why should he tell us his formula for it? This kind of question, inescapable for the attentive reader, pervades both these books. The truth of the matter, I think, is that though Nietzsche appears to be making things as direct and simple as possible, he is by now inveterately wedded to his old habit of using a single term, in this case 'happiness', to denote both something of which he approves and what he regards as its malignant shadow. The latter is invariably what most people mean by the term, the former what they should mean. In the latter part of the nineteenth century, 'happiness' was a term which had virtually been taken over by utilitarians, for whom Nietzsche's contempt was limitless. The grounds of that contempt are multiple: 1. Insofar as utilitarians concerned themselves with the greatest happiness of the greatest number, they were advocating something which for Nietzsche simply was not worth having. For an equal distribution of happiness must mean a watering down of its quality for anyone who possesses it. 2. The utilitarian conception of happiness further betrays itself in its suspect relationship to Christian ideas on the subject. Nietzsche touches on both these points when he writes in number 43 of *The Anti-Christ*: 'Salvation of the soul' – in plain words: 'The world revolves around me'.... The poison of the doctrine 'equal rights for all' – this has been more thoroughly sowed by Christianity than by anything else; from the most secret recesses of base instincts, Christianity has waged a war to the death against every feeling of reverence and distance between man and man, against, that is, the precondition of every elevation, every increase in culture – it has forged out of the resentment of the masses its chief weapon against us, against everything noble, joyful, high-spirited on earth, against our happiness on earth.... 3. Nietzsche regards the failure to draw a distinction between happiness and contentment as especially disastrous; for him the only happiness worth having is that which is the by-product of strenuous efforts in various directions, efforts undertaken without a thought for the happiness they might produce. If Nietzsche had bothered to read the utilitarians he would have seen that, at least in respect of the third of these criticisms, Mill had explicitly, indeed notoriously, claimed that it was better to be an unhappy wise man than a contented fool. But Mill figures in Nietzsche's list of 'Impossibles', where Nietzsche labels him at the beginning of 'Expeditions of an Untimely Man': 'John Stuart Mill: or offensive clarity.' If he had been a little more patient with Mill – admittedly a difficult task, and one to which he was temperamentally unsuited – he could have made his critique more effective; or rather he could have applied to Mill the more balanced critique which he does address elsewhere. Why, if one is utilitarian, is it better to be miserable and wise than stupid and contented? No answer which sustains the coherence of this doctrine has ever been forthcoming, for utilitarianism is, in fact, in all its rich confusions, the result of attempting to combine hopelessly irreconcilable elements. Its stress on equality among all men is an inheritance of

Christianity – and it is this element in Christianity that horrifies Nietzsche as much as any other – while in its emphasis on happiness in this life it negates the basic premiss of Christianity (at least as Nietzsche sees it, and it is a view generally shared). To take the latter point: the Christian Church, in opposition to its founder, has always been insistent on the worthlessness of the things of this world – this is Nietzsche’s central argument in *The Anti-Christ*. For a start they are transient, and that strong streak of Platonism in Christianity (‘Christianity is Platonism for “the people”,’ Nietzsche writes in the Preface to *Beyond Good and Evil*) had enforced the idea that anything that is not eternal is without value. Not only is it their ephemerality which eliminates their worth, but also those negative features dependent upon them: ambition, pride, ruthlessness, together with achievement and creation itself, as human beings understand it, are intelligible only in a world in which everything passes away. So also, it might be retorted, are the Christian virtues of patience, fortitude and remorse. True enough, yet they are all predicated on a future reward, just as the vices are eternally punished. In short, because utilitarianism had emerged from Christianity it attempted to apply to a world seen in a wholly secular way a set of values that makes sense only in a religious, more specifically a Christian, context. Hence, while upholding earthly happiness, it reflects its Christian legacy in its condemnation of contented zombies – a condemnation Nietzsche shares, but which he realizes that one must find radically new grounds to sustain. Other central concepts of morality discussed by Nietzsche are also meaningful only in a religious context. For instance, one of the most magnificent passages in *Twilight*, indeed in all of Nietzsche’s writings, occurs in number 5 of the ‘Expeditions of an Untimely Man’, where, attacking ‘G. Eliot’, a still more hapless victim of his demonological schema, he writes: They have got rid of the Christian God, and now feel obliged to cling all the more firmly to Christian morality... In England, in response to every little emancipation from theology one has to reassert one’s position in a fear-inspiring manner as a moral fanatic. That is the penance one pays there. – With us it is different. When one gives up Christian belief one thereby deprives oneself of the right to Christian morality. For the latter is absolutely not self-evident... Christianity is a system, a consistently thought out and complete view of things. If one breaks out of it a fundamental idea, the belief in God, one thereby breaks the whole thing to pieces:... Christianity presupposes that man does not know, cannot know what is good for him and what evil: he believes in God, who alone knows. Christian morality is a command: its origin is transcendental; it is beyond all criticism, all right to criticize; it possesses truth only if God is truth – it stands or falls with the belief in God. – If the English really do believe they will know, of their own accord, ‘intuitively’, what is good and evil; if they consequently think they no longer have need of Christianity as a guarantee of morality; that is merely the consequence of the ascendancy of

Christian evaluation and an expression of the strength and depth of this ascendancy: so that the origin of English morality has been forgotten, so that the highly conditional nature of its right to exist is no longer felt. For the Englishman morality is not yet a problem... Astonishingly accurate as this is about English moral philosophers of the last hundred years, it seems unfair of Nietzsche to attack only them, when it applies at least as much to post-Christians of other nations. But that hardly matters. What does matter is the conclusiveness of the point Nietzsche is making. It applies equally to Kant, whom Nietzsche does not spare in either of these two books. Indeed it applies more to him. For he too gets rid of the Christian God as a foundation of morality, only to reintroduce Him later on as a guarantee that virtue will pay, if not in this world then in the next. Even readers who find much of what Nietzsche writes unsympathetic must surely share his amazement, if not his indignation (though they should share that too), when they contemplate a world from which God has been eliminated but in which it is thought that we should behave just as people did, or ought to have done, when He was still a pervasive presence. The trouble is that our conception of human nature has failed to alter: we still derive it from seeing ourselves as creatures, obliged to obey the dictates of our Creator. This view of ourselves is so difficult to overcome – where do we look to find an alternative one? – and the very idea of ourselves as being continuous with the rest of nature is so reductive, that we mostly lazily stick with our Christian inheritance, which we persuade ourselves is the ‘natural’ view to take. But at the same time we realize that something is amiss, so we tinker around in an ad hoc sort of way, holding on to such concepts as ‘rights’ and ‘equality’, jettisoning or tacitly ignoring others that we find inconvenient. The result, in Nietzsche’s view, is a moral and spiritual vulgarity so depressing that he has to stage a one-man, non-stop demonstration of exaltation. Though *Twilight* ranges very widely, taking in every theme that Nietzsche ever dealt with, there can’t be any question that at each point he is preparing the ground for his final attack on Christianity. It is – the whole brief book – very much a matter of reculer pour mieux sauter. And although, reading *The Anti-Christ* immediately afterwards, one has a strong sense of more of the same, this book was actually intended to be the first instalment of his *Revaluation of All Values*, which was itself to be in four parts and to present his philosophy in its most definitive form so far – an ambitious project, even if he had not become insane. Nietzsche was touchingly addicted to plans and titles, most of which were abandoned. What is amazing is the sureness of touch with which, in both these books, he surveys the contemporary cultural scene, in addition to many other topics, and pulls all the threads together. It is in pursuance of this dynamic unity that he uses names with such dramatic unfairness. Never scrupulous, let alone ‘scholarly’, in his portrayal of individuals, he reaches new heights of recklessness in these works, with the signal exception of his treatment

of Christ, as we shall see. But it would be a terrible pity if this unfairness were to blind one to the essential points that he is making. If accuracy were at issue, Nietzsche is no more accurate in his portrayal of his heroes than he is of his villains. The whole enterprise has to be seen in terms of lining up his troops to fight the enemy, and it is a central part of his project that his own forces are enormously but not hopelessly outnumbered. Both books should be read under the aspect of the last words of *Ecce Homo*: 'Have I been understood? – Dionysos against the Crucified...' Dionysos had, of course, always been his name for what he regarded as the element in life which was most fearful but also which vindicated it; 'The Crucified' is a comparatively late piece of nomenclature for its opposite. But in fact to put the contrast in these terms is misleading and has certainly resulted in much misunderstanding, even among those who aren't hostile to Nietzsche's general position. For Dionysos has two opponents, one worthy of him, the other contemptible. The name Nietzsche gives to his worthy opponent is Christ – hence Dionysos is the Anti-Christ. But as translators of the eponymous work have pointed out, in German 'Der Antichrist' can mean either 'The Anti-Christ' or 'The Anti-Christian'. I think that it was intended to mean both. The Christian can be seen as the unworthy opponent of Dionysos, the squalid enemy who is too ubiquitous to be ignored, but who is undeservedly dignified by being treated to such elaborate condemnation. Similarly, it is Christianity, not Christ, of which Nietzsche writes in the closing passage of *The Anti-Christ* that it is 'the one great curse, the one great intrinsic depravity, the one great instinct for revenge for which no expedient is sufficiently poisonous, secret, subterranean, petty – I call it the one immortal blemish of mankind...' In the central sections of the book Nietzsche goes to great pains to distinguish between Christ and everyone who has used his name for whatever purposes. So, to simplify slightly, *The Anti-Christ* constitutes an attack on both Christ and Christians, while *Twilight* makes its assault on the exceedingly complex set of motives, feelings, attitudes and longings which have ensured that 'in reality there has been only one Christian, and he died on the Cross' (*The Anti-Christ*, number 39). To make this point clearer, it is necessary to go back to Nietzsche's first book, *The Birth of Tragedy*, as indeed he does in number 6 of the section of *Twilight* entitled '“Reason” in Philosophy', where he enunciates four propositions, the fourth of which runs: To divide the world into a 'real' and an 'apparent' world, whether in the manner of Christianity or in the manner of Kant (which is, after all, that of a cunning Christian –) is only a suggestion of *décadence* – a symptom of declining life... That the artist places a higher value on appearance than on reality constitutes no objection to this proposition. For 'appearance' here signifies reality once more, only selected, strengthened, corrected... The tragic artist is not a pessimist – it is precisely he who affirms all that is questionable and terrible in existence, he is Dionysian... Certainly, this is

not exactly the way he put it in *The Birth of Tragedy*, but the difference is not damaging, at least not for present purposes: on the contrary, it strengthens his position. For the central positive point that Nietzsche is making here, that the Dionysian artist affirms precisely what we are all most tempted to deny, is something to which he always held firm. But in *The Birth of Tragedy* ‘the terrible’ had denoted something glamorous, the underlying and mainly appalling substratum of existence which we are usually unable to face, but which the phenomenon of tragedy forces us to face. In the sixteen years between *The Birth of Tragedy* and *Twilight*, Nietzsche had abandoned the metaphysics which enabled him to postulate that substratum, while finding that ‘the terrible’ was more terrible than he had thought, because it wasn’t at all glamorous. It was everything that makes small what should be great, that saps life and will, that ministers to what Nietzsche, in his last works, came to sum up, in the word (he always puts it in French) *décadence*. And, with only an appearance of paradox, he found it more frightful than the metaphysical horrors that he had evoked in *The Birth of Tragedy*. So, now that Nietzsche has told us, perhaps a little more offhandedly than the importance of the subject warrants, that ‘“appearance” here signifies reality once more, only selected, strengthened, corrected’ he sets about doing the selecting and the correcting in order – and this is the absolutely crucial point – that he should be able to effect a final volte-face and return to his original conception of ‘the terrible’, only purged of its Schopenhauerian-Wagnerian overtones or undertones. In other words, he now wants to denote by ‘the terrible’ those elements in existence which are very nearly unendurable, but the enduring and the overcoming of which lead to an increase in strength or will. The version of ‘the terrible’ which is in one way worse is that which leads to debility and a sense of impoverished life. It is not the role of the Dionysian artist or philosopher to affirm that – it is their job to expose and extirpate it. The twilight of the idols, whether eternal or modern, is at hand. It is in this sense that Nietzsche is driven, against many explicit resolutions to the contrary, to be a No-sayer. For what the *décadents* who surround him are doing is to say No where they should be saying Yes, where they should be Dionysian; and what is leading them to this life-denying perversity, mostly of course unconsciously, is that they subscribe to a set of values that puts the central features of this world at a discount. Where they find suffering, they immediately look for someone to blame, and end up hating themselves, or generalize that into a hatred of ‘human nature’. They look for ‘peace of mind’, using it as a blanket term and failing to see the diversity of states, some of them desirable and some of them the reverse, which that term covers. They confuse cause and effect, thinking that the connection between virtue and happiness is that the former leads to the latter, whereas in fact the reverse is the case. They have, in Nietzsche’s cruelly accurate phrase, ‘the vulgar ambition to possess generous feelings’ (*‘Expeditions of an Untimely Man’*,

number 6). They confuse breeding fine men with taming them. Throughout the major part of *Twilight* this devastating list of our vulgarities continues. It goes without saying that most of Nietzsche's readers will find reasons not to be devastated. At most they will claim to find it all very stimulating, or say that they would do if Nietzsche could be a little calmer and less abusive. But really Nietzsche's impudence (he called Richard Wagner 'the impolitest of geniuses' – *The Case of Wagner*, section 1 – when he should clearly have reserved that title for himself) gives them the excuse to ignore the substance of what he is alleging. His own obsession with moral and intellectual hygiene guaranteed that throughout his life he remained aghast at and incredulous of the degree of self-deception and willingness to believe what suits them that almost everyone routinely practises. By the time he wrote his last works he had behind him a uniquely impressive series of books, especially *Human, All Too Human*, *Daybreak* and supremely *The Gay Science*, in which he had employed scrupulous analysis, teasing and satire, lyrical depth psychology; and no one had given a damn. So he produced this 'grand declaration of war', but this merely served to make people feel that they had been right all along to ignore him. His only consolation was that since he was speaking to *décadents* they would of course disagree with whatever he said. But how does one succeed in getting under the skin of a *décadent*? How does one reveal to vulgar people the catastrophic effects of their vulgarity? How does one effect any truly radical conversion in people's consciousness, especially if they are not particularly unhappy? Only, it would seem, by producing in them an experience so devastating that our paramount example of it is Saint Paul's experience on the road to Damascus – something that was never far from Nietzsche's mind when he was writing these books. And although he was desperate to achieve a similar effect, he was horrified at the way in which it was produced on that world-historical occasion. But suppose that, for all our initial resistance, we try to take *Twilight* seriously, and not as a kind of spiritual thriller or whodunit. We might begin by agreeing that some of his milder claims are, at the very least, plausible. It does seem to be true, for example, that most people, when they find something has gone wrong, do look for someone to blame quite as soon as they look for a way of putting it right. Equally, people who lack the advantages that others have form intense resentments against the 'privileged', claiming that they (the non-privileged) are being denied their 'rights'. Such movements of the soul are, it would seem, 'natural'; Nietzsche is not in the least disposed to deny that. What he loathes is the way in which such attitudes of vengefulness and resentment are used as the linchpins of moral systems. It is inevitable that they should be, at any rate when the gulf between the haves and the have-nots is sufficiently obtrusive and when there are sufficiently skilful people around to work on the feelings of deprivation in the majority. But as a result a set of values is

inaugurated in which these feelings of an essentially hostile kind are institutionalized as the sole morality for humanity. It goes without saying that there are other factors which constitute the basic elements of the kind of morality that Nietzsche is particularly opposed to a – ‘slave’ or ‘herd’ morality – but he is tirelessly insistent on the crucial role of these feelings of deprivation. Not that we are consistent on this score. Take the case of jealousy: it is widely and rightly taken to be a destructive and corrosive emotion liable to have catastrophic effects both on those who suffer from it and, as a likely consequence, on the object or objects of their jealousy. We regard it with horror and alarm both because its destructiveness is so blatant, and because the context in which it typically arises is one in which the objects of jealousy are not to blame for being its cause. Still, it seems to be as ‘natural’ as any emotion we have. And yet it is hard to see what the difference is between jealousy and those other feelings which give rise to morality as we most commonly know it. We can take the argument a painful stage further: someone (a ‘decent’ person) who recognizes the degrading effects of jealousy may decide to try to escape from them by behaving in a ‘noble’ way: he forswears the courses of action which he feels driven to follow, and indulges ‘the vulgar ambition to have generous feelings’ (‘Expeditions of an Untimely Man’, number 6). (Hegel had already expounded this dialectic of feeling and action in *The Phenomenology of Spirit*. Nietzsche often echoes Hegel, but almost certainly without realizing it.) How can we escape from this whole ghastly and spiritually debilitating cycle of feeling? Only by denying the process in its very beginnings, which will involve, among other things, seeing that the ‘nobility’ of the person feeling and acting within this kind of morality (which we tend to regard as morality per se) is a very different matter from the genuine nobility of the person who recognizes the true conditions of existence from the start; who recognizes that there are, as Nietzsche often puts it, no ‘moral facts’, no ‘natural rights’ to which we can lay claim, no valid concept of blame. Who would such a person be? It isn’t surprising that Nietzsche found it necessary to coin the term *Übermensch* (usually, if unfortunately, rendered as ‘Superman’). For, as I have already argued, our concept of what human nature is is so permeated with our moral concepts that to attempt to sort out the one from the other is by now almost certainly vain. In the course of these two books Nietzsche, although primarily on the warpath, gives fairly detailed accounts of two kinds of person that he finds it impossible to condemn as incarnations, of however ‘sublimated’ (a favourite, and very influential, term of his) a kind, of morality as it is ordinarily understood. One of these kinds of person truly deserves the title of Superman, even if there hasn’t yet been a complete example of it. The other class contains only one member, and that is Christ, at least as seen by Nietzsche in his idiosyncratic but extraordinarily powerful and moving depiction of him in the central stretch of *The Anti-Christ*. It is this second kind of person whom Nietzsche feels is

sufficiently impressive to be his arch-opponent: Dionysos against the Crucified. It is in number 28 of *The Anti-Christ* that Nietzsche touches ‘for the first time... on the problem of the psychology of the redeemer’. The point of his doing so is to contrast him with the type of the priest, who figures in this book as the arch-villain though not the arch-opponent. The priest is, in Nietzsche’s violently abusive account, the embodiment of meanness seeking, all too successfully, to persuade his flock (which comes dangerously close to being coextensive with the Western world) to live their lives wholly in accordance with the concepts of fear and loathing. By contrast the redeemer, from now on referred to by Nietzsche as Jesus, lives entirely without rancour or vindictiveness. This is no news: but Nietzsche observes that, in attempting to categorize such an extraordinary, indeed unique, being, theologians, of whom he singles out Renan for special derision, have appropriated for their ‘explication of the type Jesus the two most inapplicable concepts possible in this case: the concept of the genius and the concept of the hero’. He immediately continues in number 29: But if anything is unevangelic it is the concept hero. Precisely the opposite of all contending, of all feeling oneself in struggle has here become instinct: the incapacity for resistance here becomes morality (‘resist not evil!’: the profoundest saying of the Gospel, its key in a certain sense), blessedness in peace, in gentleness, in the inability for enmity. What are the ‘glad tidings’? True life, eternal life is found – it is not promised, it is here, it is within you: as life lived in love, in love without deduction or exclusion, without distance. Everyone is a child of God – Jesus definitely claims nothing for himself alone – as a child of God everyone is equal to everyone else.... To make a hero of Jesus! – And what a worse misunderstanding is the word ‘genius’! The idiosyncrasies of Nietzsche’s interpretation of Christ’s character are obvious, but then any attempt to extract an intelligible portrayal of him from the gospels is bound to be selective. What takes one by surprise is the nature of Nietzsche’s selectivity. As his eight-page account continues – he does a good deal more than merely ‘touching on’ the psychology of the redeemer – the tone becomes ever warmer and even ecstatic. The portrayal of Nietzsche’s (or Dionysos’s) antipode becomes, bizarrely, one of the most moving passages in the whole of his writings. With the occasional omission, it could be used as a magnificent sermon addressed to a devout congregation. The omissions which would have to be made are crucial; from time to time in this piece of exalted prose Nietzsche refers to Jesus as an idiot, though his use of that term is clearly influenced by Nietzsche’s belated discovery of Dostoyevsky, to whom he refers favourably several times, but only in these two books. Jesus is also described as a *décadent*, and as a case of retarded puberty. These descriptions are undoubtedly sincere, yet the fact remains that Nietzsche is obviously at least as much in love with the portrayal of the redeemer that he finds himself giving as he is with that of Socrates, that other sublime opponent, with

whom he had a still more protracted affair of the spirit. Both of them fascinated him, partly by virtue of possessing natures which didn't say No simply because they could not conceive of an alternative morality, which, had they been able to, would have both horrified and fatally corrupted them. If one can't have innocence – a matter about which Nietzsche never made up his mind – at least ignorance, or certain species of it, is the next best thing. In the end it won't do, of course, and certainly not for someone with such paralyzingly absolute demands on life as Nietzsche. But lacking a paradigm of genuine innocence, he reverted at several crucial places in his writings to the appeal of 'pure folly'. Not that he could use that phrase in a positive sense, since Wagner had preempted it in his characterization of Parsifal, for whom Nietzsche had nothing but scorn. So he uses instead the closely related image of the child. The most celebrated place in which he does that is the passage in the first section of 'Zarathustra's Discourses' in *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*, where he describes the three metamorphoses of the spirit and concludes that it is in its ideal state when, having shed the weights of the camel and the ferocities of the lion, it becomes a child. Many readers of that passage must have rubbed their eyes and wondered whether it is a planned effect, so unmistakably to echo the words of Christ. Nietzsche's point, I think, though he doesn't make it explicitly, is that we must retain the innocence of the child as we mature. But is that possible? Whatever his answer, the point about Christ is that he wants us to remain as little children, just as (according to Nietzsche) he himself did in crucial and finally damaging respects. Christ didn't suffer from passions, because he didn't have any, at any rate not the ones that usually accompany adulthood. Thus he was unacquainted with sin and guilt, and his evangel is utterly uncombative. 'If I understand anything of this great symbolist', Nietzsche writes in number 34 of *The Anti-Christ*, 'it is that he took for realities, for "truths", only inner realities.' The idea of cultivating pure inwardness, freed from any external demands, including that of physical culture (in both these books Nietzsche is very emphatic about the primacy of the body), is clearly one that Nietzsche found very attractive, mainly because of the central place that music played in his life, so long as music is regarded as the most intense form of inwardness that we can possess without importing large quantities of metaphysics and religion. For he insisted, finally, on regarding it as the ultimate refreshment of the hard-worked spirit, and not as a source of truth – in which latter role it would lead us straight back to Schopenhauer and Wagner. But to cultivate inwardness and nothing more, as Christ did, is to avoid life in an absolute, in its way glorious, but ultimately perverse fashion. Indeed, no one but Christ managed to do it. He was bound to be comprehensively misunderstood, and the history of Christianity is a history of misunderstanding. 'This "bringer of glad tidings" died as he lived, as he taught – not to "redeem mankind" but to demonstrate how one ought to live. What he bequeathed to mankind is his

practice' (number 35, *The Anti-Christ*). Inevitably Christ's disciples, and especially Paul, didn't see things that way, according to Nietzsche. They turned action into doctrine, mistook symbols for facts, and produced the most repulsive set of teachings known to mankind (not, alas, that mankind was disposed or able to recognize them for what they were). After the haunting beauty of the pages dedicated to Christ, Nietzsche returns sadly to his overriding theme. The beginning of number 38 runs: 'At this point I shall not suppress a sigh. There are days when I am haunted by a feeling blacker than the blackest melancholy – contempt of man. And so as to leave no doubt as to what I despise, whom I despise: it is the man of today, the man with whom I am fatefully contemporary.' Most of the rest of the book is devoted to attacking Christianity in its institutional form, and especially the way in which it has corrupted consciousness to such an extent that it isn't even true to its own vile self. Nietzsche is embarrassed at the obviousness of the point he is making in number 38: Everyone knows this: and everyone none the less remains unchanged. Where have the last feelings of decency and self-respect gone when even our statesmen, in other ways very unprejudiced kind of men and practical anti-Christians through and through, still call themselves Christians today and go to Communion?... A young prince at the head of his regiments, splendid as the expression of his people's egoism and presumption – but without any shame professing himself a Christian!... Whom then does Christianity deny? what does it call 'world'? The charge is unanswerable: we are faced with a debasement of a debasement of something fundamentally life-denying. No wonder Nietzsche became a hermit. Dionysos against the Crucified... But who might be Dionysos? Who is adequate to command the imagination in the face of a symbol as profound as that of Christ on the Cross? Especially when our imaginations are permeated by that symbol, however comprehensively we have betrayed it. Nietzsche has either to find an exemplary anti-Christian from the past, or to postulate a kind of figure who hasn't yet existed. He had tried the latter in Zarathustra, with questionable success. In these last books he resorts to two historical figures, the first of them a notorious product of the Renaissance, the second 'a grand attempt to overcome the eighteenth century through a return to nature, through a going-up to the naturalness of the Renaissance, a kind of self-overcoming on the part of that century'. This second figure is, of course, Goethe, and number 49 of 'Expeditions of an Untimely Man' is a magnificent celebration of him. The first figure is Cesare Borgia, no doubt chosen partly for shock-value, but also because Nietzsche did – all his references to Borgia show it – have a genuine admiration for him as an embodiment of the Renaissance, which he interprets as: 'The revaluation of Christian values, the attempt, undertaken with every expedient, with every instinct, with genius of every kind, to bring about the victory of the opposing values, the noble values...' (*The Anti-Christ*, number 61). It becomes a

bit clearer why Nietzsche should have been so determinedly provocative: ‘Cesare Borgia as Pope... Am I understood?... Very well, that would have been a victory of the only sort I desire today: Christianity would thereby have been abolished!’ (number 61). My only criticism of this is that Nietzsche seems to be far too retrospectively hopeful. When one thinks of what Christianity has survived, it seems unlikely that anyone or anything could abolish it. Nor is it clear that if an adequate Dionysos-figure appeared he wouldn’t suffer the same fate that afflicts all great men – he would acquire disciples, whether or not he wanted them – and if he were truly great, he wouldn’t want them. And once again there would be a new ‘-ism’, most of whose members would be mean and degrading, because most people are. Nietzsche wanted to envisage a figure so prodigiously magnificent that he could not be traduced. Even the furious pages of these two books show that he still hoped for such a person, and for the transformation of consciousness that he might achieve. If the word ‘pathetic’ can ever be applied to Nietzsche – it is certainly the last term he would have found tolerable – it would be for his optimism about man, in the face of our accumulated record of mean-spiritedness, which no one knew better than he did.

MICHAEL TANNER Translator’s Note Nietzsche was born in Röcken, a village in Prussian Saxony, in 1844. His father and both grandfathers were Lutheran pastors and as a boy he was a pious believer. He attended Pforta school, the Rugby of Prussia, from 1858 to 1864, and then went to Bonn and subsequently Leipzig University (1864–9). At Bonn he studied theology but gave it up when he lost his religious faith; he continued as a student of philology and gained so great a reputation in it that he was appointed to the chair of classical philology at Basel University at the age of twenty-four before having obtained his doctorate, which was awarded him by Leipzig without examination. He taught at Basel for ten years (1869–79), becoming a Swiss to do so, and published his earliest books: *The Birth of Tragedy* (1872) and the four *Untimely Meditations* (1873–6). He also became a ‘disciple’ of Richard Wagner and devoted much time and energy to assisting in establishing the Bayreuth Festival, which was inaugurated in 1876. But by that time Nietzsche had come to think he had been mistaken in seeing in Wagner the new saviour of German art, and this disillusionment, combined with his sense that the newly established Reich was a victory for philistinism, turned him against all things German and he became year by year more critical of the ‘new Germany’ (see ‘What the Germans Lack’ in *Twilight*). In 1876 he began writing *Human, All Too Human*, and when it appeared in 1878 his breach with his past was complete. A year later he suffered an almost total collapse of health and was compelled to abandon his university career: for the next ten years he lived in a state of recurring ill-health which culminated in final collapse and insanity. During these years he wrote all his important books, living in lodgings and hotel rooms mainly in Switzerland and Italy. He was for that

decade certainly one of the loneliest of men, though fundamentally he liked and needed solitude. He never married. The *Birth of Tragedy* and the first of the *Untimely Meditations* won him a certain small notoriety, but his subsequent books fell dead from the press – only 170 copies of *Human, All Too Human* were sold during its first year – and from the fourth part of *Zarathustra* onwards he had to pay for their publication himself (which he could ill afford to do). Until the end of 1887, in spite of having produced a series of books without equal in the German literature of their time and now world-famous, he was virtually unknown. In 1888 he began to acquire a name: a few, mainly hostile articles were written about him in journals, and the Danish critic Georg Brandes lectured in Copenhagen on his works. But it was not until the 1890s that the public in Germany and abroad became aware of him, and then his reputation suddenly soared, so that by 1900 he was famous, not to say notorious. Of this he knew nothing, having become mentally a child again. Alone, ill and unsuccessful, Nietzsche in the 1880s is however not a figure to pity: in one book after another, couched in a style it must have been a perpetual delight to realize, he celebrated as no one else has ever done the splendour, power and joy of life. *Note on the Text Götzen-Dämmerung, oder: Wie man mit dem Hammer philosophiert* was published by C. G. Naumann of Leipzig in January 1889, a few weeks after Nietzsche's collapse. It was the last book Nietzsche himself saw printed. It was written between the end of June and the beginning of September 1888, with the foreword, the chapter 'What the Germans Lack' and some of the 'Expeditions of an Untimely Man' added at the end of September, and it was printed by the end of October. The book originally bore the title *Müssiggang eines Psychologen* (A Psychologist's Leisure, or The Idle Hours of a Psychologist): this modest title was objected to by Nietzsche's enthusiastic admirer Peter Gast, who urged him to find something more 'splendid'; Nietzsche acceded to this request with a parody of Wagner's *Götterdämmerung* (Twilight of the Gods). The change seems to have been made while the book was already being set up in type (the title page of the manuscript from which it was set is missing, indicating perhaps that Nietzsche had taken it back to make the alteration and that it was subsequently mislaid), and this explains a few otherwise puzzling references to the superseded title in the text. *Der Antichrist* was written between 3 and 30 September 1888, immediately after the completion of *Twilight*. It was first intended as the first part of *The Revaluation of all Values*: a plan for that book which has been preserved reads: 'Revaluation of all Values. Book 1: The Anti-Christ. Attempt at a Critique of Christianity. Book 2: The Free Spirit. Critique of Philosophy as a Nihilistic Movement. Book 3: The Immoralist. Critique of the Most Fatal Kind of Ignorance, Morality. Book 4: Dionysos. Philosophy of Eternal Recurrence.' There are two surviving manuscript title pages of *The Anti-Christ*: the earlier follows the above plan: *The Anti-Christ. Attempt at a Critique of Christianity*.

Book One of the Revaluation of all Values, and was presumably written on 3 September. The later one reads: The Anti-Christ. Revaluation of all Values, but the subtitle has been crossed out and A Curse on Christianity substituted. The book was first published in 1895, in volume VIII of the Gesamtausgabe in Grossoktav (Naumann, Leipzig); a small number of omissions from the text were subsequently published and are restored in Karl Schlechta's edition (Werke in drei Bänden, vol. II, 1955). R. J. HOLLINGDALE FURTHER READING David B. Allison, *Reading the New Nietzsche* (2001) MaudeMarie Clark, *Nietzsche on Truth and Morality* (1990) R. J. Hollingdale, *Nietzsche: The Man and His Philosophy* (1965; 1999) Brian Leiter, *Nietzsche on Morality* (2002) Bernd Magnus and Kathleen Higgins (eds.), *The Cambridge Companion to Nietzsche* (1996) Alexander Nehemas, *Nietzsche: Life as Literature* (1985) F. Nietzsche, *Daybreak: Thoughts on the Prejudices of Morality*, trans. R. J. Hollingdale, introduction by M. Tanner (1982) _ _ _ , *Dithyrambs of Dionysus*, trans, with introduction and notes R. J. Hollingdale (1984; 2001) _ _ _ , *Untimely Meditations*, trans. R. J. Hollingdale, introduction by J. P. Stern (1983) John Richardson and Brian Leiter (eds.), *Nietzsche* (2001) Rudiger Safranski, *Nietzsche: A Philosophical Biography*, trans. Shelley Frisch (2002) Henry Staten, *Nietzsche's Voice* (1990) Tracy Strong, *Friedrich Nietzsche and the Politics of Transfiguration* (1988) TWILIGHT OF THE IDOLS or How to Philosophize with a Hammer Foreword To stay cheerful when involved in a gloomy and exceedingly responsible business is no inconsiderable art: yet what could be more necessary than cheerfulness? Nothing succeeds in which high spirits play no part. Only excess of strength is proof of strength. – A revaluation of all values, this question-mark so black, so huge it casts a shadow over him who sets it up – such a destiny of a task compels one every instant to run out into the sunshine so as to shake off a seriousness grown all too oppressive. Every expedient for doing so is justified, every 'occasion' a joyful occasion.* Above all, war. War has always been the grand sagacity of every spirit which has grown too inward and too profound; its curative power lies even in the wounds one receives. A maxim whose origin I withhold from learned curiosity has long been my motto: *increscunt animi, virescit volnere virtus*.† Another form of recovery, in certain cases even more suited to me, is to sound out idols.... There are more idols in the world than there are realities: that is my 'evil eye' for this world, that is also my 'evil ear'.... For once to pose questions here with a hammer and perhaps to receive for answer that famous hollow sound which speaks of inflated bowels – what a delight for one who has ears behind his ears – for an old psychologist and pied piper like me, in presence of whom precisely that which would like to stay silent has to become audible... This book too* – the title betrays it† – is above all a relaxation, a sunspot, an escapade into the idle hours of a psychologist. Perhaps also a new war? And are new idols sounded out?... This little book is a

grand declaration of war; and as regards the sounding-out of idols, this time they are not idols of the age but eternal idols which are here touched with the hammer as with a tuning fork – there are no more ancient idols in existence.... Also none more hollow.... That does not prevent their being the most believed in; and they are not, especially in the most eminent case, called idols... FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE Turin, 30 September 1888, on the day the first book of the *Revaluation of all Values* was completed. Maxims and Arrows 1. Idleness is the beginning of psychology. What? could psychology be – a vice? 2. Even the bravest of us rarely has the courage for what he really knows... 3. To live alone one must be an animal or a god – says Aristotle. There is yet a third case: one must be both – a philosopher. 4. ‘All truth is simple’ – Is that not a compound lie? – 5. Once and for all, there is a great deal I do not want to know. – Wisdom sets bounds even to knowledge. 6. It is by being ‘natural’ that one best recovers from one’s unnaturalness, from one’s spirituality... 7. Which is it? Is man only God’s mistake or God only man’s mistake? – 8. From the military school of life. – What does not kill me makes me stronger. 9. Help thyself: then everyone will help thee too. Principle of Christian charity. 10. Let us not be cowardly in face of our actions! Let us not afterwards leave them in the lurch! – Remorse of conscience is indecent. 11. Can an ass be tragic? – To be crushed by a burden one can neither bear nor throw off?... The case of the philosopher. 12. If we possess our why of life we can put up with almost any how. – Man does not strive after happiness; only the Englishman does that. 13. Man created woman – but what out of? Out of a rib of his God, of his ‘ideal’... 14. What? you are seeking? you want to multiply yourself by ten, by a hundred? you are seeking followers? – Seek noughts! –* 15. Posthumous men – like me, for instance – are not so well understood as timely† men, but they are listened to better. More precisely: we are never understood – and hence our authority... 16. Among women. – ‘Truth? Oh, you don’t know the truth, do you! Is it not an outrage on all out pudeurs?’ – 17. This is an artist as an artist should be, modest in his requirements: there are only two things he really wants, his bread and his art – panem et Circen...‡ into them: that is, he believes there is a will in them already (principle of ‘belief’). 19. What? you have chosen virtue and the heaving bosom, yet at the same time look with envy on the advantages enjoyed by those who live for the day? – But with virtue one renounces ‘advantage’... (laid at the door of an anti-Semite). 20. The complete woman perpetrates literature in the same way as she perpetrates a little sin: as an experiment, in passing, looking around to see if someone notices and so that someone may notice... 21. To get into only those situations in which illusory virtues are of no use, but in which, like the tightrope-walker on his rope, one either falls or stands – or gets off... 22. ‘Bad men have no songs’.* – How is it the Russians have songs? 23. ‘German spirit’:† for eighteen years‡ a contradictio in adjecto.§ 24. In order to look for beginners one becomes a crab.

The historian looks backwards; at last he also believes backwards. 25. Contentment protects one even from catching a cold. Has a woman who knew she was well dressed ever caught a cold? – I am assuming she was hardly dressed at all. 26. I mistrust all systematizers and avoid them. The will to a system is a lack of integrity. 27. Women are considered deep – why? because one can never discover any bottom to them. Women are not even shallow. 28. If a woman possesses manly virtues one should run away from her; and if she does not possess them she runs away herself. 29. ‘How much the conscience formerly had to bite on! || what good teeth it had! – And today? what’s the trouble?’ – A dentist’s question. 30. One seldom commits only one rash act. In the first rash act one always does too much. For just that reason one usually commits a second – and then one does too little... 31. When it is trodden on a worm will curl up.* That is prudent. It thereby reduces the chance of being trodden on again. In the language of morals: humility. – 32. Hatred of lies and dissembling may arise out of a sensitive notion of honour; the same hatred may arise out of cowardice, in as much as lying is forbidden by divine command. Too cowardly to tell lies... life would be a mistake. The German even thinks of God as singing songs.† 34. On ne peut penser et écrire qu’assis ‡ (G. Flaubert). – Now I have you, nihilist! Assiduity§ is the sin against the holy spirit. Only ideas won by walking have any value. 35. There are times when we are like horses, we psychologists, and grow restive: we see our own shadow moving up and down before us. The psychologist has to look away from himself in order to see at all. 36. Whether we immoralists do virtue any harm? – As little as anarchists do princes. Only since they have been shot at do they again sit firmly on their thrones. Moral: one must shoot at morals. 37. You run on ahead? – Do you do so as a herdsman? or as an exception? A third possibility would be as a deserter.... First question of conscience. 38. Are you genuine? or only an actor? A representative? or that itself which is represented? – Finally you are no more than an imitation of an actor.... Second question of conscience. 39. The disappointed man speaks. – I sought great human beings, I never found anything but the apes of their ideal. 40. Are you one who looks on? or who sets to work? – or who looks away, turns aside.... Third question of conscience. 41. Do you want to accompany? or go on ahead? or go off alone?... One must know what one wants and that one wants. – Fourth question of conscience. 42. For me they were steps, I have climbed up upon them – therefore I had to pass over them. But they thought I wanted to settle down on them... 43. What does it matter that I am proved right! I am too much in the right. – And he who laughs best today will also laugh last. The Problem of Socrates 1 In every age the wisest have passed the identical judgement on life: it is worthless. ... Everywhere and always their mouths have uttered the same sound – a sound full of doubt, full of melancholy, full of weariness with life, full of opposition to life. Even Socrates said as he died: ‘To

live – that means to be a long time sick: I owe a cock to the saviour Asclepius’.* Even Socrates had had enough of it. – What does that prove? What does it point to? – Formerly one would have said (– oh, and did say, and loudly enough, and our pessimists† most of all!): ‘Here at any rate there must be something true! The consensus sapientium ‡ is proof of truth.’ – Shall we still speak thus today? are we allowed to do so? ‘Here at any rate there must be something sick’ – this is our retort: one ought to take a closer look at them, these wisest of every age! Were they all of them perhaps no longer steady on their legs? belated? tottery? décadents? Does wisdom perhaps appear on earth as a raven which is inspired by the smell of carrion?... 2 This irreverent notion that the great sages are declining types first dawned on me in regard to just the case in which learned and unlearned prejudice is most strongly opposed to it: I recognized Socrates and Plato as symptoms of decay, as agents of the dissolution of Greece, as pseudo-Greek, as anti-Greek (Birth of Tragedy, 1872).*. That consensus sapientium – I saw more and more clearly – proves least of all that they were right about what they were in accord over: it proves rather that they themselves, these wisest men, were in some way in physiological accord since they stood – had to stand – in the same negative relation to life. Judgements, value judgements concerning life, for or against, can in the last resort never be true: they possess value only as symptoms, they come into consideration only as symptoms – in themselves such judgements are stupidities. One must reach out and try to grasp this astonishing finesse, that the value of life cannot be estimated. Not by a living man, because he is a party to the dispute, indeed its object, and not the judge of it; not by a dead one, for another reason. – For a philosopher to see a problem in the value of life thus even constitutes an objection to him, a question-mark as to his wisdom, a piece of unwisdom. – What? and all these great wise men – they have not only been décadents, they have not even been wise? – But I shall get back to the problem of Socrates. 3 Socrates belonged, in his origins, to the lowest orders: Socrates was rabble. One knows, one sees for oneself, how ugly he was. But ugliness, an objection in itself, is among Greeks almost a refutation. Was Socrates a Greek at all? Ugliness is frequently enough the sign of a thwarted development, a development retarded by interbreeding. Otherwise it appears as a development in decline. Anthropologists among criminologists tell us the typical criminal is ugly: monstrum in fronte, monstrum in animo.† But the criminal is a décadent. Was Socrates a typical criminal? – At least that famous physiognomist’s opinion which Socrates’ friends found so objectionable would not contradict this idea. A foreigner passing through Athens who knew how to read faces told Socrates to his face that he was a monstrum – that he contained within him every kind of foul vice and lust. And Socrates answered merely: ‘You know me, sir!’ – 4 It is not only the admitted dissoluteness and anarchy of his instincts which indicate décadence in Socrates: the superfetation of the logical

and that barbed malice which distinguishes him also point in that direction. And let us not forget those auditory hallucinations which, as 'Socrates' demon', have been interpreted in a religious sense. Everything about him is exaggerated, buffo, caricature, everything is at the same time hidden, reserved, subterranean. – I seek to understand out of what idiosyncrasy that Socratic equation reason = virtue = happiness derives: that bizarrest of equations and one which has in particular all the instincts of the older Hellenes against it. 5 With Socrates Greek taste undergoes a change in favour of dialectics: what is really happening when that happens? It is above all the defeat of a nobler taste; with dialectics the rabble gets on top. Before Socrates, the dialectical manner was repudiated in good society: it was regarded as a form of bad manners, one was compromised by it. Young people were warned against it. And all such presentation of one's reasons was regarded with mistrust. Honest things, like honest men, do not carry their reasons exposed in this fashion. It is indecent to display all one's goods. What has first to have itself proved is of little value. Wherever authority is still part of accepted usage and one does not 'give reasons' but commands, the dialectician is a kind of buffoon: he is laughed at, he is not taken seriously. – Socrates was the buffoon who got himself taken seriously: what was really happening when that happened? 6 One chooses dialectics only when one has no other expedient. One knows that dialectics inspire mistrust, that they are not very convincing. Nothing is easier to expunge than the effect of a dialectician, as is proved by the experience of every speech-making assembly. Dialectics can be only a last-ditch weapon in the hands of those who have no other weapon left. One must have to enforce one's rights: otherwise one makes no use of it. That is why the Jews were dialecticians; Reynard the Fox was a dialectician: what? and Socrates was a dialectician too? – 7 – Is Socrates' irony an expression of revolt? of the resentment of the rabble? does he, as one of the oppressed, enjoy his own form of ferocity in the knife-thrust of the syllogism? does he revenge himself on the aristocrats he fascinates? – As a dialectician one is in possession of a pitiless instrument; with its aid one can play the tyrant; one compromises by conquering. The dialectician leaves it to his opponent to demonstrate he is not an idiot: he enrages, he at the same time makes helpless. The dialectician devitalizes his opponent's intellect. – What? is dialectics only a form of revenge in the case of Socrates? 8 I have intimated the way in which Socrates could repel: it is therefore all the more necessary to explain the fact that he exercised fascination. – That he discovered a new kind of agon, that he was the first fencing-master in it for the aristocratic circles of Athens, is one reason. He fascinated because he touched on the agonal instinct of the Hellenes – he introduced a variation into the wrestling-matches among the youths and young men. Socrates was also a great erotic. 9 But Socrates divined even more. He saw behind his aristocratic Athenians; he grasped that his case, the idiosyncrasy of his case, was already no

longer exceptional. The same kind of degeneration was everywhere silently preparing itself: the old Athens was coming to an end. – And Socrates understood that all the world had need of him – his expedient, his cure, his personal art of selfpreservation.... Everywhere the instincts were in anarchy; everywhere people were but five steps from excess: the monstrum in animo was the universal danger. ‘The instincts want to play the tyrant; we must devise a counter-tyrant who is stronger’. ... When that physiognomist had revealed to Socrates what he was, a cave of every evil lust, the great ironist uttered a phrase that provides the key to him. ‘That is true,’ he said, ‘but I have become master of them all.’ How did Socrates become master of himself? – His case was after all only the extreme case, only the most obvious instance of what had at that time begun to be the universal exigency: that no one was any longer master of himself, that the instincts were becoming mutually antagonistic. He exercised fascination as this extreme case – his fear-inspiring ugliness expressed it for every eye to see: he fascinated even more, it goes without saying, as the answer, as the solution, as the apparent cure for this case. – 10 If one needs to make a tyrant of reason, as Socrates did, then there must exist no little danger of something else playing the tyrant. Rationality was at that time divined as a saviour; neither Socrates nor his ‘invalids’ were free to be rational or not, as they wished – it was *de rigueur*, it was their last expedient. The fanaticism with which the whole of Greek thought throws itself at rationality betrays a state of emergency: one was in peril, one had only one choice: either to perish or – be absurdly rational.... The moralism of the Greek philosophers from Plato downwards is pathologically conditioned: likewise their estimation of dialectics. Reason = virtue = happiness means merely: one must imitate Socrates and counter the dark desires by producing a permanent daylight – the daylight of reason. One must be prudent, clear, bright at any cost: every yielding to the instincts, to the unconscious, leads downwards... 11 I have intimated the way in which Socrates exercised fascination: he seemed to be a physician, a saviour. Is it necessary to go on to point out the error which lay in his faith in ‘rationality at any cost’? – It is self-deception on the part of philosophers and moralists to imagine that by making war on *décadence* they therewith elude *décadence* themselves. This is beyond their powers: what they select as an expedient, as a deliverance, is itself only another expression of *décadence* – they alter its expression, they do not abolish the thing itself. Socrates was a misunderstanding: the entire morality of improvement, the Christian included, has been a misunderstanding.... The harshest daylight, rationality at any cost, life bright, cold, circumspect, conscious, without instinct, in opposition to the instincts, has itself been no more than a form of sickness, another form of sickness – and by no means a way back to ‘virtue’, to ‘health’, to happiness.... To have to combat one’s instincts – that is the formula for *décadence*: as long as life is ascending, happiness and instinct are one. – 12 – Did

he himself grasp that, this shrewdest of all self-deceivers? Did he at last say that to himself in the wisdom of his courage for death?... Socrates wanted to die – it was not Athens, it was he who handed himself the poison cup, who compelled Athens to hand him the poison cup.... ‘Socrates is no physician,’ he said softly to himself: ‘death alone is a physician here.... Socrates himself has only been a long time sick...’ ‘Reason’ in Philosophy 1 You ask me about the idiosyncrasies of philosophers?... There is their lack of historical sense, their hatred of even the idea of becoming, their Egyptianism. They think they are doing a thing honour when they dehistoricize it, sub specie aeterni* – when they make a mummy of it. All that philosophers have handled for millennia has been conceptual mummies; nothing actual has escaped from their hands alive. They kill, they stuff, when they worship, these conceptual idolaters – they become a mortal danger to everything when they worship. Death, change, age, as well as procreation and growth, are for them objections – refutations even. What is, does not become; what becomes, is not.... Now they all believe, even to the point of despair, in that which is. But since they cannot get hold of it, they look for reasons why it is being withheld from them. ‘It must be an illusion, a deception which prevents us from perceiving that which is: where is the deceiver to be found?’ – ‘We’ve got it,’ they cry in delight, ‘it is the senses! These senses, which are so immoral as well, it is they which deceive us about the real world. Moral: escape from sense-deception, from becoming, from history, from falsehood – history is nothing but belief in the senses, belief in falsehood. Moral: denial of all that believes in the senses, of all the rest of mankind: all of that is mere “people”. Be a philosopher, be a mummy, represent monotonism by a gravedigger-mimicry! – And away, above all, with the body, that pitiable idée fixe of the senses! infected with every error of logic there is, refuted, impossible even, notwithstanding it is impudent enough to behave as if it actually existed!’... 2 I set apart with high reverence the name of Heraclitus. When the rest of the philosopher crowd rejected the evidence of the senses because these showed plurality and change, he rejected their evidence because they showed things as if they possessed duration and unity. Heraclitus too was unjust to the senses, which lie neither in the way the Eleatics* believe nor as he believed – they do not lie at all. It is what we make of their evidence that first introduces a lie into it, for example the lie of unity, the lie of materiality, of substance, of duration.... ‘Reason’ is the cause of our falsification of the evidence of the senses. In so far as the senses show becoming, passing away, change, they do not lie.... But Heraclitus will always be right in this, that being is an empty fiction. The ‘apparent’ world is the only one: the ‘real’ world has only been lyingly added... 3 – And what subtle instruments for observation we possess in our senses! This nose, for example, of which no philosopher has hitherto spoken with respect and gratitude, is none the less the most delicate tool we have at our command: it can detect minimal

differences in movement which even the spectroscope cannot detect. We possess scientific knowledge today to precisely the extent that we have decided to accept the evidence of the senses – to the extent that we have learned to sharpen and arm them and to think them through to their conclusions. The rest is abortion and not-yet-science: which is to say metaphysics, theology, psychology, epistemology. Or science of formulae, sign-systems: such as logic and that applied logic, mathematics. In these reality does not appear at all, not even as a problem; just as little as does the question what value a system of conventional signs such as constitutes logic can possibly possess. 4 The other idiosyncrasy of philosophers is no less perilous: it consists in mistaking the last for the first. They put that which comes at the end – unfortunately! for it ought not to come at all! – the ‘highest concepts’, that is to say the most general, the emptiest concepts, the last fumes of evaporating reality, at the beginning as the beginning. It is again only the expression of their way of doing reverence: the higher must not be allowed to grow out of the lower, must not be allowed to have grown at all.... Moral: everything of the first rank must be *causa sui*. * Origin in something else counts as an objection, as casting a doubt on value. All supreme values are of the first rank, all the supreme concepts – that which is, the unconditioned, the good, the true, the perfect – all that cannot have become, must therefore be *causa sui*. But neither can these supreme concepts be incommensurate with one another, be incompatible with one another.... Thus they acquired their stupendous concept ‘God’.... The last, thinnest, emptiest is placed as the first, as cause in itself, as *ens realissimum*.†... That mankind should have taken seriously the brain-sick fancies of morbid cobweb-spinners! – And it has paid dearly for doing so!... 5 – Let us, in conclusion, set against this the very different way in which we (– I say ‘we’ out of politeness...) view the problem of error and appearance. Change, mutation, becoming in general were formerly taken as proof of appearance, as a sign of the presence of something which led us astray. Today, on the contrary, we see ourselves as it were entangled in error, necessitated to error, to precisely the extent that our prejudice in favour of reason compels us to posit unity, identity, duration, substance, cause, materiality, being; however sure we may be, on the basis of a strict reckoning, that error is to be found here. The situation is the same as with the motions of the sun: in that case error has our eyes, in the present case our language as a perpetual advocate. Language belongs in its origin to the age of the most rudimentary form of psychology: we find ourselves in the midst of a rude fetishism when we call to mind the basic presuppositions of the metaphysics of language – which is to say, of reason. It is this which sees everywhere deed and doer; this which believes in will as cause in general; this which believes in the ‘ego’, in the ego as being, in the ego as substance, and which projects its belief in the ego-substance on to all things – only thus does it create the concept ‘thing’.... Being is everywhere thought in, foisted on, as cause; it is only from

the conception 'ego' that there follows, derivatively, the concept 'being'.... At the beginning stands the great fateful error that the will is something which produces an effect – that will is a faculty.... Today we know it is merely a word.... Very much later, in a world a thousand times more enlightened, the security, the subjective certainty with which the categories of reason* could be employed came all of a sudden into philosophers' heads: they concluded that these could not have originated in the empirical world – indeed, the entire empirical world was incompatible with them. Where then do they originate? – And in India as in Greece they committed the same blunder: 'We must once have dwelt in a higher world' – instead of in a very much lower one, which would have been the truth! – 'we must have been divine, for we possess reason!'... Nothing, in fact, has hitherto had a more direct power of persuasion than the error of being as it was formulated by, for example, the Eleatics: for every word, every sentence we utter speaks in its favour! – Even the opponents of the Eleatics were still subject to the seductive influence of their concept of being: Democritus, among others, when he invented his atom.... 'Reason' in language: oh what a deceitful old woman! I fear we are not getting rid of God because we still believe in grammar... 6 It will be a matter for gratitude if I now compress so fundamental and new an insight into four theses: I shall thereby make it easier to understand, I shall thereby challenge contradiction. First proposition. The grounds upon which 'this' world has been designated as apparent establish rather its reality – another kind of reality is absolutely undemonstrable. Second proposition. The characteristics which have been assigned to the 'real being' of things are the characteristics of non-being, of nothingness – the 'real world' has been constructed out of the contradiction to the actual world: an apparent world indeed, in so far as it is no more than a moral-optical illusion. Third proposition. To talk about 'another' world than this is quite pointless, provided that an instinct for slandering, disparaging and accusing life is not strong within us: in the latter case we revenge ourselves on life by means of the phantasmagoria of 'another', a 'better' life. Fourth proposition. To divide the world into a 'real' and an 'apparent' world, whether in the manner of Christianity or in the manner of Kant (which is, after all, that of a cunning Christian –) is only a suggestion of *décadence* – a symptom of declining life.... That the artist places a higher value on appearance than on reality constitutes no objection to this proposition. For 'appearance' here signifies reality once more, only selected, strengthened, corrected.... The tragic artist is not a pessimist – it is precisely he who affirms all that is questionable and terrible in existence, he is Dionysian... How the 'Real World' at last Became a Myth HISTORY OF AN ERROR 1. The real world, attainable to the wise, the pious, the virtuous man – he dwells in it, he is it. (Oldest form of the idea, relatively sensible, simple, convincing. Transcription of the proposition 'I, Plato, am the truth.')

)* 2. The real world, unattainable for the

moment, but promised to the wise, the pious, the virtuous man ('to the sinner who repents'). (Progress of the idea: it grows more refined, more enticing, more incomprehensible – it becomes a woman, it becomes Christian...) 3. The real world, unattainable, undemonstrable, cannot be promised, but even when merely thought of a consolation, a duty, an imperative. (Fundamentally the same old sun, but shining through mist and scepticism; the idea grown sublime, pale, northerly, Königsbergian.)† 4. The real world – unattainable? Unattained, at any rate. And if unattained also unknown. Consequently also no consolation, no redemption, no duty: how could we have a duty towards something unknown? (The grey of dawn. First yawnings of reason. Cockcrow of positivism.)‡ 5. The 'real world' – an idea no longer of any use, not even a duty any longer – an idea grown useless, superfluous, consequently a refuted idea: let us abolish it! (Broad daylight; breakfast; return of cheerfulness and *bons sens*; Plato blushes for shame; all free spirits run riot.) 6. We have abolished the real world: what world is left? the apparent world perhaps?... But no! with the real world we have also abolished the apparent world! (Mid-day; moment of the shortest shadow; end of the longest error; zenith of mankind; INCIPIT ZARATHUSTRA)*

Morality as Anti-Nature

1 There is a time with all passions when they are merely fatalities, when they drag their victim down with the weight of their folly – and a later, very much later time when they are wedded with the spirit, when they are 'spiritualized'. Formerly one made war on passion itself on account of the folly inherent in it: one conspired for its extermination – all the old moral monsters are unanimous that 'il faut tuer les passions'.* The most famous formula for doing this is contained in the New Testament, in the Sermon on the Mount, where, by the way, things are not at all regarded from a lofty standpoint. There, for example, it is said, with reference to sexuality, 'if thy eye offend thee, pluck it out': fortunately no Christian follows this prescription. To exterminate the passions and desires merely in order to do away with their folly and its unpleasant consequences – this itself seems to us today merely an acute form of folly. We no longer admire dentists who pull out the teeth to stop them hurting.... On the other hand, it is only fair to admit that on the soil out of which Christianity grew the concept 'spiritualization of passion' could not possibly be conceived. For the primitive Church, as is well known, fought against the 'intelligent' in favour of the 'poor in spirit': how could one expect from it an intelligent war against passion? – The Church combats the passions with excision in every sense of the word: its practice, its 'cure' is castration. It never asks: 'How can one spiritualize, beautify, deify a desire?' – it has at all times laid the emphasis of its discipline on extirpation (of sensuality, of pride, of lust for power, of avarice, of revengefulness). – But to attack the passions at their roots means to attack life at its roots: the practice of the Church is hostile to life... 2 The same expedient – castration, extirpation – is instinctively selected in a struggle against a desire by

those who are too weak-willed, too degenerate to impose moderation upon it: by those natures which need La Trappe,* to speak metaphorically (and not metaphorically –), some sort of definitive declaration of hostility, a chasm between themselves and a passion. It is only the degenerate who cannot do without radical expedients; weakness of will, more precisely the inability not to react to a stimulus, is itself merely another form of degeneration. Radical hostility, mortal hostility towards sensuality is always a thought-provoking symptom: it justifies making certain conjectures as to the general condition of one who is excessive in this respect. – That hostility, that hatred reaches its height, moreover, only when such natures are no longer sufficiently sound even for the radical cure, for the renunciation of their ‘devil’. Survey the entire history of priests and philosophers, and that of artists as well: the most virulent utterances against the senses have not come from the impotent, nor from ascetics, but from those who found it impossible to be ascetics, from those who stood in need of being ascetics... 3 The spiritualization of sensuality is called love: it is a great triumph over Christianity. A further triumph is our spiritualization of enmity. It consists in profoundly grasping the value of having enemies: in brief, in acting and thinking in the reverse of the way in which one formerly acted and thought. The Church has at all times desired the destruction of its enemies: we, we immoralists and antiChristians, see that it is to our advantage that the Church exist.... In politics, too, enmity has become much more spiritual – much more prudent, much more thoughtful, much more forbearing. Almost every party grasps that it is in the interest of its own self-preservation that the opposing party should not decay in strength; the same is true of grand politics. A new creation in particular, the new Reich for instance, has more need of enemies than friends: only in opposition does it feel itself necessary, only in opposition does it become necessary.... We adopt the same attitude towards the ‘enemy within’: there too we have spiritualized enmity, there too we have grasped its value. One is fruitful only at the cost of being rich in contradictions; one remains young only on condition the soul does not relax, does not long for peace.... Nothing has grown more alien to us than that desideratum of former times ‘peace of soul’, the Christian desideratum; nothing arouses less envy in us than the moral cow and the fat contentment of the good conscience.... One has renounced grand life when one renounces war.... In many cases, to be sure, ‘peace of soul’ is merely a misunderstanding – something else that simply does not know how to give itself a more honest name. Here, briefly and without prejudice, are a few of them. ‘Peace of soul’ can, for example, be the gentle radiation of a rich animality into the moral (or religious) domain. Or the beginning of weariness, the first of the shadows which evening, every sort of evening, casts. Or a sign that the air is damp, that south winds are on the way. Or unconscious gratitude for a good digestion (sometimes called ‘philanthropy’). Or the quiescence of the

convalescent for whom all things have a new taste and who waits.... Or the condition which succeeds a vigorous gratification of our ruling passion, the pleasant feeling of a rare satiety. Or the decrepitude of our will, our desires, our vices. Or laziness persuaded by vanity to deck itself out as morality. Or the appearance of a certainty, even a dreadful certainty, after the protracted tension and torture of uncertainty. Or the expression of ripeness and mastery in the midst of action, creation, endeavour, volition, a quiet breathing, 'freedom of will' attained.... Twilight of the Idols: who knows? perhaps that too is only a kind of 'peace of soul'...

4 – I formulate a principle. All naturalism in morality, that is all healthy morality, is dominated by an instinct of life – some commandment of life is fulfilled through a certain canon of 'shall' and 'shall not', some hindrance and hostile element on life's road is thereby removed. Anti-natural morality, that is virtually every morality that has hitherto been taught, revered and preached, turns on the contrary precisely against the instincts of life – it is a now secret, now loud and impudent condemnation of these instincts. By saying 'God sees into the heart' it denies the deepest and the highest desires of life and takes God for the enemy of life.... The saint in whom God takes pleasure is the ideal castrate.... Life is at an end where the 'kingdom of God' begins...

5 If one has grasped the blasphemousness of such a rebellion against life as has, in Christian morality, become virtually sacrosanct, one has fortunately therewith grasped something else as well: the uselessness, illusoriness, absurdity, falsity of such a rebellion. For a condemnation of life by the living is after all no more than the symptom of a certain kind of life: the question whether the condemnation is just or unjust has not been raised at all. One would have to be situated outside life, and on the other hand to know it as thoroughly as any, as many, as all who have experienced it, to be permitted to touch on the problem of the value of life at all: sufficient reason for understanding that this problem is for us an inaccessible problem. When we speak of values we do so under the inspiration and from the perspective of life: life itself evaluates through us when we establish values.... From this it follows that even that anti-nature of a morality which conceives God as the contrary concept to and condemnation of life is only a value judgement on the part of life – of what life? of what kind of life? – But I have already given the answer: of declining, debilitated, weary, condemned life. Morality as it has been understood hitherto – as it was ultimately formulated by Schopenhauer as 'denial of the will to life' – is the instinct of *décadence* itself, which makes out of itself an imperative: it says: 'Perish!' – it is the judgement of the judged...

6 Let us consider finally what naïvety it is to say 'man ought to be thus and thus!' Reality shows us an enchanting wealth of types, the luxuriance of a prodigal play and change of forms: and does some pitiful journeyman moralist say at the sight of it: 'No! man ought to be different'?... He even knows how man ought to be, this bigoted wretch; he paints himself on the wall and says 'ecce homo'!... But even

when the moralist merely turns to the individual and says to him: ‘You ought to be thus and thus’ he does not cease to make himself ridiculous. The individual is, in his future and in his past, a piece of fate, one law more, one necessity more for everything that is and everything that will be. To say to him ‘change yourself’ means to demand that everything should change, even in the past.... And there have indeed been consistent moralists who wanted man to be different, namely virtuous, who wanted him in their own likeness, namely that of a bigot: to that end they denied the world! No mean madness! No modest presumption!... In so far as morality condemns as morality and not with regard to the aims and objects of life, it is a specific error with which one should show no sympathy, an idiosyncrasy of the degenerate which has caused an unspeakable amount of harm!... We others, we immoralists, have on the contrary opened wide our hearts to every kind of understanding, comprehension, approval. We do not readily deny, we seek our honour in affirming. We have come more and more to appreciate that economy which needs and knows how to use all that which the holy lunacy of the priest, the diseased reason of the priest rejects; that economy in the law of life which derives advantage even from the repellent species of the bigot, the priest, the virtuous man – what advantage? – But we ourselves, we immoralists, are the answer to that... The Four Great Errors 1 The error of confusing cause and consequence. – There is no more dangerous error than that of mistaking the consequence for the cause: I call it reason’s intrinsic form of corruption. None the less, this error is among the most ancient and most recent habits of mankind: it is even sanctified among us, it bears the names ‘religion’ and ‘morality’. Every proposition formulated by religion and morality contains it; priests and moral legislators are the authors of this corruption of reason. – I adduce an example. Everyone knows the book of the celebrated Cornaro in which he recommends his meagre diet as a recipe for a long and happy life – a virtuous one, too. Few books have been so widely read; even now many thousands of copies are printed in England every year. I do not doubt that hardly any book (the Bible rightly excepted) has done so much harm, has shortened so many lives, as this curiosity, which was so well meant. The reason: mistaking the consequence for the cause. The worthy Italian saw in his diet the cause of his long life: while the prerequisite of long life, an extraordinarily slow metabolism, a small consumption, was the cause of his meagre diet. He was not free to eat much or little as he chose, his frugality was not an act of ‘free will’: he became ill when he ate more. But if one is not a bony fellow of this sort one does not merely do well, one positively needs to eat properly. A scholar of our day, with his rapid consumption of nervous energy, would kill himself with Cornaro’s regimen. Credo experto. – 2 The most general formula at the basis of every religion and morality is: ‘Do this and this, refrain from this and this – and you will be happy! Otherwise....’ Every morality, every religion is this imperative – I

call it the great original sin of reason, immortal unreason. In my mouth this formula is converted into its reverse – first example of my ‘revaluation of all values’: a well-constituted human being, a ‘happy one’, must perform certain actions and instinctively shrinks from other actions, he transports the order of which he is the physiological representative into his relations with other human beings and with things. In a formula: his virtue is the consequence of his happiness.... Long life, a plentiful posterity is not the reward of virtue, virtue itself is rather just that slowing down of the metabolism which also has, among other things, a long life, a plentiful posterity, in short Cornarism, as its outcome. – The Church and morality say: ‘A race, a people perishes through vice and luxury’. My restored reason says: when a people is perishing, degenerating physiologically, vice and luxury (that is to say the necessity for stronger and stronger and more and more frequent stimulants, such as every exhausted nature is acquainted with) follow therefrom. A young man grows prematurely pale and faded. His friends say: this and that illness is to blame. I say: that he became ill, that he failed to resist the illness, was already the consequence of an impoverished life, an hereditary exhaustion. The newspaper reader says: this party will ruin itself if it makes errors like this. My higher politics says: a party which makes errors like this is already finished – it is no longer secure in its instincts. Every error, of whatever kind, is a consequence of degeneration of instinct, disgregation of will: one has thereby virtually defined the bad. Everything good is instinct – and consequently easy, necessary, free. Effort is an objection, the god is typically distinguished from the hero (in my language: light feet are the first attribute of divinity). 3 The error of a false causality. – We have always believed we know what a cause is: but whence did we derive our knowledge, more precisely our belief we possessed this knowledge? From the realm of the celebrated ‘inner facts’, none of which has up till now been shown to be factual. We believed ourselves to be causal agents in the act of willing; we at least thought we were there catching causality in the act. It was likewise never doubted that all the antecedentia of an action, its causes, were to be sought in the consciousness and could be discovered there if one sought them – as ‘motives’: for otherwise one would not have been free to perform it, responsible for it. Finally, who would have disputed that a thought is caused? that the ego causes the thought?... Of these three ‘inner facts’ through which causality seemed to be guaranteed the first and most convincing was that of will as cause; the conception of a consciousness (‘mind’) as cause and later still that of the ego (the ‘subject’) as cause are merely after-products after causality had, on the basis of will, been firmly established as a given fact, as empiricism.... Meanwhile, we have thought better. Today we do not believe a word of it. The ‘inner world’ is full of phantoms and false lights: the will is one of them. The will no longer moves anything, consequently no longer explains anything – it merely

accompanies events, it can also be absent. The so-called 'motive': another error. Merely a surface phenomenon of consciousness, an accompaniment to an act, which conceals rather than exposes the antecedentia of the act. And as for the ego! It has become a fable, a fiction, a play on words: it has totally ceased to think, to feel and to will!... What follows from this? There are no spiritual causes at all! The whole of the alleged empiricism which affirmed them has gone to the devil! That is what follows! – And we had made a nice misuse of that 'empiricism', we had created the world on the basis of it as a world of causes, as a world of will, as a world of spirit. The oldest and longest-lived psychology was at work here – indeed it has done nothing else: every event was to it an action, every action the effect of a will, the world became for it a multiplicity of agents, an agent ('subject') foisted itself upon every event. Man projected his three 'inner facts', that in which he believed more firmly than in anything else, will, spirit, ego, outside himself – he derived the concept 'being' only from the concept 'ego', he posited 'things' as possessing being according to his own image, according to his concept of the ego as cause. No wonder he later always discovered in things only that which he had put into them! –The thing itself, to say it again, the concept 'thing' is merely a reflection of the belief in the ego as cause. ... And even your atom, messieurs mechanists and physicists, how much error, how much rudimentary psychology, still remains in your atom! – To say nothing of the 'thing in itself',* that horrendum pudendum† of the metaphysicians! The error of spirit as cause mistaken for reality! And made the measure of reality! And called God! – 4 The error of imaginary causes. – To start from the dream: on to a certain sensation, the result for example of a distant cannon-shot, a cause is subsequently foisted (often a whole little novel in which precisely the dreamer is the chief character). The sensation, meanwhile, continues to persist, as a kind of resonance: it waits, as it were, until the cause-creating drive permits it to step into the foreground – now no longer as a chance occurrence but as 'meaning'. The cannon-shot enters in a causal way, in an apparent inversion of time. That which comes later, the motivation, is experienced first, often with a hundred details which pass like lightning, the shot follows.... What has happened? The ideas engendered by a certain condition have been misunderstood as the cause of that condition. – We do just the same thing, in fact, when we are awake. Most of our general feelings – every sort of restraint, pressure, tension, explosion in the play and counter-play of our organs, likewise and especially the condition of the nervus sympathicus – excite our cause-creating drive: we want to have a reason for feeling as we do – for feeling well or for feeling ill. It never suffices us simply to establish the mere fact that we feel as we do: we acknowledge this fact – become conscious of it – only when we have furnished it with a motivation of some kind. – The memory, which in such a case becomes active without our being aware of it, calls up earlier

states of a similar kind and the causal interpretations which have grown out of them – not their causality. To be sure, the belief that these ideas, the accompanying occurrences in the consciousness, were causes is also brought up by the memory. Thus there arises an habituation to a certain causal interpretation which in truth obstructs and even prohibits an investigation of the cause. 5

Psychological explanation. – To trace something unknown back to something known is alleviating, soothing, gratifying and gives moreover a feeling of power. Danger, disquiet, anxiety attend the unknown – the first instinct is to eliminate these distressing states. First principle: any explanation is better than none. Because it is at bottom only a question of wanting to get rid of oppressive ideas, one is not exactly particular about what means one uses to get rid of them: the first idea which explains that the unknown is in fact the known does so much good that one ‘holds it for true’. Proof by pleasure (‘by potency’) as criterion of truth. – The cause-creating drive is thus conditioned and excited by the feeling of fear. The question ‘why?’ should furnish, if at all possible, not so much the cause for its own sake as a certain kind of cause – a soothing, liberating, alleviating cause. That something already known, experienced, inscribed in the memory is posited as cause is the first consequence of this need. The new, the unexperienced, the strange is excluded from being cause. – Thus there is sought not only some kind of explanation as cause, but a selected and preferred kind of explanation, the kind by means of which the feeling of the strange, new, unexperienced is most speedily and most frequently abolished – the most common explanations. – Consequence: a particular kind of cause-ascription comes to preponderate more and more, becomes concentrated into a system and finally comes to dominate over the rest, that is to say simply to exclude other causes and explanations. – The banker thinks at once of ‘business’, the Christian of ‘sin’, the girl of her love. 6 The entire realm of morality and religion falls under this concept of imaginary causes. – ‘Explanation’ of unpleasant general feelings. They arise from beings hostile to us (evil spirits: most celebrated case – hysterics misunderstood as witches). They arise from actions we cannot approve of (the feeling of ‘sin’, of ‘culpability’ foisted upon a physiological discomfort – one always finds reasons for being discontented with oneself). They arise as punishments, as payment for something we should not have done, should not have been (generalized in an impudent form by Schopenhauer into a proposition in which morality appears for what it is, the actual poisoner and calumniator of life: ‘Every great pain, whether physical or mental, declares what it is we deserve; for it could not have come upon us if we had not deserved it.’ *World as Will and Idea* II 666). They arise as the consequences of rash actions which have turned out badly (– the emotions, the senses assigned as ‘cause’, as ‘to blame’; physiological states of distress construed, with the aid of other states of distress, as ‘deserved’). – ‘Explanation’ of pleasant general feelings. They arise from trust

in God. They arise from the consciousness of good actions (the so-called ‘good conscience’, a physiological condition sometimes so like a sound digestion as to be mistaken for it). They arise from the successful outcome of undertakings (– naïve fallacy: the successful outcome of an undertaking certainly does not produce any pleasant general feelings in a hypochondriac or a Pascal). They arise from faith, hope and charity – the Christian virtues. – In reality all these supposed explanations are consequential states and as it were translations of pleasurable and unpleasurable feelings into a false dialect: one is in a state in which one can experience hope because the physiological basic feeling is once more strong and ample; one trusts in God because the feeling of plenitude and strength makes one calm. – Morality and religion fall entirely under the psychology of error: in every single case cause is mistaken for effect; or the effect of what is believed true is mistaken for the truth; or a state of consciousness is mistaken for the causation of this state. 7 The error of free will. – We no longer have any sympathy today with the concept of ‘free will’: we know only too well what it is – the most infamous of all the arts of the theologian for making mankind ‘accountable’ in his sense of the word, that is to say for making mankind dependent on him.... I give here only the psychology of making men accountable. – Everywhere accountability is sought, it is usually the instinct for punishing and judging which seeks it. One has deprived becoming of its innocence if being in this or that state is traced back to will, to intentions, to accountable acts: the doctrine of will has been invented essentially for the purpose of punishment, that is of finding guilty. The whole of the old-style psychology, the psychology of will, has as its precondition the desire of its authors, the priests at the head of the ancient communities, to create for themselves a right to ordain punishments – or their desire to create for God a right to do so.... Men were thought of as ‘free’ so that they could become guilty: consequently, every action had to be thought of as willed, the origin of every action as lying in the consciousness (– whereby the most fundamental falsification in psychology was made into the very principle of psychology).... Today, when we have started to move in the reverse direction, when we immoralists especially are trying with all our might to remove the concept of guilt and the concept of punishment from the world and to purge psychology, history, nature, the social institutions and sanctions of them, there is in our eyes no more radical opposition than that of the theologians, who continue to infect the innocence of becoming with ‘punishment’ and ‘guilt’ by means of the concept of the ‘moral world-order’. Christianity is a hangman’s metaphysics... 8 What alone can our teaching be? – That no one gives a human being his qualities: not God, not society, not his parents or ancestors, not he himself (– the nonsensical idea here last rejected was propounded, as ‘intelligible freedom’, by Kant, and perhaps also by Plato before him). No one is accountable for existing

at all, or for being constituted as he is, or for living in the circumstances and surroundings in which he lives. The fatality of his nature cannot be disentangled from the fatality of all that which has been and will be. He is not the result of a special design, a will, a purpose; he is not the subject of an attempt to attain to an 'ideal of man' or an 'ideal of happiness' or an 'ideal of morality' – it is absurd to want to hand over his nature to some purpose or other. We invented the concept 'purpose': in reality purpose is lacking.... One is necessary, one is a piece of fate, one belongs to the whole, one is in the whole – there exists nothing which could judge, measure, compare, condemn our being, for that would be to judge, measure, compare, condemn the whole.... But nothing exists apart from the whole! – That no one is any longer made accountable, that the kind of being manifested cannot be traced back to a *causa prima** that the world is a unity neither as sensorium nor as 'spirit', this alone is the great liberation – thus alone is the innocence of becoming restored.... The concept 'God' has hitherto been the greatest objection to existence.... We deny God; in denying God, we deny accountability: only by doing that do we redeem the world. – The 'Improvers' of Mankind 1 One knows my demand of philosophers that they place themselves beyond good and evil – that they have the illusion of moral judgement beneath them. This demand follows from an insight first formulated by me: that there are no moral facts whatever. Moral judgement has this in common with religious judgement that it believes in realities which do not exist. Morality is only an interpretation of certain phenomena, more precisely a misinterpretation. Moral judgement belongs, as does religious judgement, to a level of ignorance at which even the concept of the real, the distinction between the real and the imaginary, is lacking: so that at such a level 'truth' denotes nothing but things which we today call 'imaginings'. To this extent moral judgement is never to be taken literally: as such it never contains anything but nonsense. But as semeiotics it remains of incalculable value: it reveals, to the informed man at least, the most precious realities of cultures and inner worlds which did not know enough to 'understand' themselves. Morality is merely signlanguage, merely symptomatology: one must already know what it is about to derive profit from it. 2 A first example, merely as an introduction. In all ages one has wanted to 'improve' men: this above all is what morality has meant. But one word can conceal the most divergent tendencies. Both the taming of the beast man and the breeding of a certain species of man has been called 'improvement': only these zoological termini express realities – realities, to be sure, of which the typical 'improver', the priest, knows nothing – wants to know nothing.... To call the taming of an animal its 'improvement' is in our ears almost a joke. Whoever knows what goes on in menageries is doubtful whether the beasts in them are 'improved'. They are weakened, they are made less harmful, they become sickly beasts through the depressive emotion of fear, through pain, through injuries, through hunger. – It is

no different with the tamed human being whom the priest has ‘improved’. In the early Middle Ages, when the Church was in fact above all a menagerie, one everywhere hunted down the fairest specimens of the ‘blond beast’* – one ‘improved’, for example, the noble Teutons. But what did such a Teuton afterwards look like when he had been ‘improved’ and led into a monastery? Like a caricature of a human being, like an abortion: he had become a ‘sinner’, he was in a cage, one had imprisoned him behind nothing but sheer terrifying concepts.... There he lay now, sick, miserable, filled with ill-will towards himself; full of hatred for the impulses towards life, full of suspicion of all that was still strong and happy. In short, a ‘Christian’.... In physiological terms: in the struggle with the beast, making it sick can be the only means of making it weak. This the Church understood: it corrupted the human being, it weakened him – but it claimed to have ‘improved’ him... 3 Let us take the other aspect of so-called morality, the breeding of a definite race and species. The most grandiose example of this is provided by Indian morality, sanctioned, as the ‘Law of Manu’, into religion. Here the proposed task is to breed no fewer than four races simultaneously: a priestly, a warrior, and a trading and farming race, and finally a menial race, the Sudras. Here we are manifestly no longer among animal-tamers: a species of human being a hundred times more gentle and rational is presupposed even to conceive the plan of such a breeding. One draws a breath of relief when coming out of the Christian sick-house and dungeon atmosphere into this healthier, higher, wider world. How paltry the ‘New Testament’ is compared with Manu, how ill it smells! – But this organization too needed to be dreadful – this time in struggle not with the beast but with its antithesis, with the non-bred human being, the hotchpotch human being, the Chandala.* And again it had no means of making him weak and harmless other than making him sick – it was the struggle with the ‘great majority’. Perhaps there is nothing which outrages our feelings more than these protective measures of Indian morality. The third edict, for example (Avadana-Shastra I), that ‘concerning unclean vegetables’, ordains that the only nourishment permitted the Chandala shall be garlic and onions, in view of the fact that holy scripture forbids one to give them corn or seed-bearing fruits or water or fire. The same edict lays it down that the water they need must not be taken from rivers or springs or pools, but only from the entrances to swamps and holes made by the feet of animals. They are likewise forbidden to wash their clothes or to wash themselves, since the water allowed them as an act of charity must be used only for quenching the thirst. Finally, the Sudra women are forbidden to assist the Chandala women in childbirth, and the latter are likewise forbidden to assist one another.... – The harvest of such hygienic regulations did not fail to appear: murderous epidemics, hideous venereal diseases and, as a consequence, ‘the law of the knife’ once more, ordaining circumcision for the male and removal of the

labia minora for the female children. – Manu himself says: ‘The Chandala are the fruit of adultery, incest and crime’ (– this being the necessary consequence of the concept ‘breeding’). ‘They shall have for clothing only rags from corpses, for utensils broken pots, for ornaments old iron, for worship only evil spirits; they shall wander from place to place without rest. They are forbidden to write from left to right and to use the right hand for writing: the employment of the right hand and of the left-to-right motion is reserved for the virtuous, for people of race.’ – 4 These regulations are instructive enough: in them we find for once Aryan humanity, quite pure, quite primordial – we learn that the concept ‘pure blood’ is the opposite of a harmless concept. It becomes clear, on the other hand, in which people the hatred, the Chandala hatred for this ‘humanity’ has been immortalized, where it has become religion, where it has become genius.... From this point of view, the Gospels are documents of the first rank; the Book of Enoch even more so. – Christianity, growing from Jewish roots and comprehensible only as a product of this soil,* represents the reaction against that morality of breeding, of race, of privilege – it is the anti-Aryan religion par excellence: Christianity the revaluation of all Aryan values, the victory of Chandala values, the evangel preached to the poor and lowly, the collective rebellion of everything downtrodden, wretched, illconstituted, under-privileged against the ‘race’ – undying Chandala revenge as the religion of love... 5 The morality of breeding and the morality of taming are, in the means they employ to attain their ends, entirely worthy of one another: we may set down as our chief proposition that to make morality one must have the unconditional will to the contrary. This is the great, the uncanny problem which I have pursued furthest: the psychology of the ‘improvers’ of mankind. A small and really rather modest fact, that of so-called *pia fraus*,† gave me my first access to this problem: *pia fraus*, the heritage of all philosophers and priests who have ‘improved’ mankind. Neither Manu nor Plato, neither Confucius nor the Jewish and Christian teachers, ever doubted their right to tell lies. Nor did they doubt their possession of other rights.... Expressed in a formula one might say: every means hitherto employed with the intention of making mankind moral has been thoroughly immoral. – What the Germans Lack 1 Among Germans today it is not enough to possess spirit: one must also possess the presumption to possess it... Perhaps I know the Germans, perhaps I might even venture to address a few words to them. The new Germany represents a great quantity of inherited and inculcated ability, so that it may for a time be allowed even a lavish expenditure of its accumulated store of energy. It is not a high culture that has here gained ascendancy, even less a fastidious taste, a noble ‘beauty’ of the instincts, but more manly virtues than any other country of Europe can exhibit. A good deal of courage and respect for oneself, a good deal of self-confidence in social dealings and in the performance of reciprocal duties, a good deal of industriousness, a good deal of endurance –

and an inherited moderation which requires the goad rather than the brake. I also add that here people can still obey without being humiliated by obeying.... And no one despises his adversary... You will see I want to be just to the Germans: I would not like to be untrue to myself in this – so I must also tell them what I object to. Coming to power is a costly business: power makes stupid.... The Germans – once they were called the nation of thinkers: do they still think at all? Nowadays the Germans are bored with intellect, the Germans mistrust intellect, politics devours all seriousness for really intellectual things – Deutschland, Deutschland über alles was, I fear, the end of German philosophy.... ‘Are there any German philosophers? are there any German poets? are there any good German books?’ – people ask me abroad. I blush; but with the courage which is mine even in desperate cases I answer: ‘Yes, Bismarck!’ – Dare I go so far as to confess which books are read nowadays?... Confounded instinct of mediocrity! – 2 – Who has not pondered sadly over what the German spirit could be! But this nation has deliberately made itself stupid, for practically a thousand years: nowhere else are the two great European narcotics, alcohol and Christianity, so viciously abused. Lately even a third has been added, one which is capable by itself of completely obstructing all delicate and audacious flexibility of spirit: music, our constipated, constipating German music. – How much dreary heaviness, lameness, dampness, sloppiness, how much beer there is in the German intellect! How can it possibly happen that young men who dedicate their existence to the most spiritual goals lack all sense of the first instinct of spirituality, the spirit’s instinct for self-preservation – and drink beer?... The alcoholism of scholarly youth perhaps does not constitute a question mark in regard to their erudition – one can be even a great scholar without possessing any spirit at all – but from any other point of view it remains a problem. – Where does one not find that bland degeneration which beer produces in the spirit! Once, in a case that has become almost famous, I laid my finger on such an instance of degeneration – the degeneration of our first German freethinker, the shrewd David Strauss, into the author of an alehouse gospel and a ‘new faith’.... It was no vain vow he made in verse to the ‘gracious brunette’* – fidelity unto death... 3 – I have said of the German spirit that it is growing coarser, that it is growing shallow. Is that sufficient? – Fundamentally, it is something quite different which appals me: how German seriousness, German profundity, German passion in spiritual things is more and more on the decline. It is the pathos and not merely the intellectual aspect which has altered. – I come in contact now and then with German universities: what an atmosphere prevails among its scholars, what a barren spirituality, grown how contented and lukewarm! It would be a profound misunderstanding to adduce German science as an objection here, as well as being proof one had not read a word I have written. For seventeen years I have not wearied of exposing the despiritualizing

influence of our contemporary scientific pursuits. The harsh Helot condition to which the tremendous extent of science has condemned every single person today is one of the main reasons why education and educators appropriate to fuller, richer, deeper natures are no longer forthcoming. Our culture suffers from nothing more than it suffers from the superabundance of presumptuous journeymen and fragments of humanity; our universities are, against their will, the actual forcing-houses for this kind of spiritual instinct-atrophy. And all Europe already has an idea of this – grand politics deceives no one.... Germany counts more and more as Europe's flatland. – I am still looking for a German with whom I could be serious after my fashion – how much more for one with whom I might be cheerful! – Twilight of the Idols: ah, who today could grasp from how profound a seriousness a hermit is here relaxing! – The most incomprehensible thing about us is our cheerfulness... 4 If one makes a reckoning, it is obvious not only that German culture is declining, the sufficient reason* for it is obvious too. After all, no one can spend more than he has – that is true of individuals, it is also true of nations. If one spends oneself on power, grand politics, economic affairs, world commerce, parliamentary institutions, military interests – if one expends in this direction the quantum of reason, seriousness, will, self-overcoming that one is, then there will be a shortage in the other direction. Culture and the state – one should not deceive oneself over this – are antagonists: the 'cultural state' is merely a modern idea. The one lives off the other, the one thrives at the expense of the other. All great cultural epochs are epochs of political decline: that which is great in the cultural sense has been unpolitical, even anti-political.... Goethe's heart opened up at the phenomenon Napoleon – it closed up to the 'Wars of Liberation'.... The moment Germany rises as a great power, France gains a new importance as a cultural power. A great deal of current spiritual seriousness and passion has already emigrated to Paris; the question of pessimism, for instance, the Wagner question, virtually every psychological and artistic question, is speculated on with incomparably more subtlety and thoroughness there than in Germany – the Germans are even incapable of this kind of seriousness. – In the history of European culture the rise of the 'Reich' signifies one thing above all: a displacement of the centre of gravity. The fact is known everywhere: in the main thing – and that is still culture – the Germans no longer come into consideration. The question is asked: haven't you so much as one spirit who means something to Europe? in the way your Goethe, your Hegel, your Heinrich Heine, your Schopenhauer meant something? That there is no longer a single German philosopher – there is no end of astonishment at that. – 5 The essential thing has gone out of the entire system of higher education in Germany: the end, as well as the means to the end. That education, culture, itself is the end – and not 'the Reich' – that educators are required for the attainment of this end – and not grammar-school teachers and

university scholars – that too has been forgotten.... There is a need for educators who are themselves educated; superior, noble spirits, who prove themselves every moment by what they say and by what they do not say: cultures grown ripe and sweet – and not the learned boors which grammar school and university offer youth today as ‘higher nurses’. Educators, the first prerequisite of education, are lacking (except for the exceptions of exceptions): hence the decline of German culture. – One of those rarest of exceptions is my honoured friend Jacob Burckhardt of Basel: it is to him above all that Basel owes its pre-eminence in the humanities. – What the ‘higher schools’ of Germany in fact achieve is a brutal breaking-in with the aim of making, in the least possible time, numberless young men fit to be utilized, utilized to the full and used up, in the state service. ‘Higher education’ and numberless – that is a contradiction to start with. All higher education belongs to the exceptions alone: one must be privileged to have a right to so high a privilege. Great and fine things can never be common property: *pulchrum est paucorum hominum*.^{*} – What is the cause of the decline of German culture? That ‘higher education’ is no longer a privilege – the democratism of ‘culture’ made ‘universal’ and common.... Not to overlook the fact that military privileges absolutely compel too great attendance at higher schools, which means their ruin. – No one is any longer free in present-day Germany to give his children a noble education: our ‘higher’ schools are one and all adjusted – as regards their teachers, their curricula and their instructional aims – to the most dubious mediocrity. And there reigns everywhere an indecent haste, as if something has been neglected if the young man of twenty-three is not yet ‘finished and ready’, does not yet know the answer to the ‘chief question’: which calling? – A higher kind of human being, excuse me for saying, doesn’t think much of ‘callings’, the reason being he knows himself called.... He takes his time, he has plenty of time, he gives no thought whatsoever to being ‘finished and ready’ – at the age of thirty one is, as regards high culture, a beginner, a child. – Our overcrowded grammar schools, our overloaded, stupified grammar-school teachers, are a scandal: one may perhaps have motives for defending this state of things, as the professors of Heidelberg recently did – there are no grounds for doing so. ⁶ To be true to my nature, which is affirmative and has dealings with contradiction and criticism only indirectly and when compelled, I shall straightaway set down the three tasks for the sake of which one requires educators. One has to learn to see, one has to learn to think, one has to learn to speak and write: the end in all three is a noble culture. – Learning to see – habituating the eye to repose, to patience, to letting things come to it; learning to defer judgement, to investigate and comprehend the individual case in all its aspects. This is the first preliminary schooling in spirituality: not to react immediately to a stimulus, but to have the restraining, stock-taking instincts in one’s control. Learning to see, as I understand it, is almost what is called in

unphilo-sophical language ‘strong will-power’: the essence of it is precisely not to ‘will’, the ability to defer decision. All unspirituality, all vulgarity, is due to the incapacity to resist a stimulus – one has to react, one obeys every impulse. In many instances, such a compulsion is already morbidity, decline, a symptom of exhaustion – almost everything which unphilosophical crudity designates by the name ‘vice’ is merely this physiological incapacity not to react – A practical application of having learned to see: one will have become slow, mistrustful, resistant as a learner in general. In an attitude of hostile calm one will allow the strange, the novel of every kind to approach one first – one will draw one’s hand back from it. To stand with all doors open, to prostrate oneself submissively before every petty fact, to be ever itching to mingle with, plunge into other people and other things, in short our celebrated modern ‘objectivity’, is bad taste, is ignoble par excellence. – 7 Learning to think: our schools no longer have any idea what this means. Even in our universities, even among students of philosophy themselves, the theory, the practice, the vocation of logic is beginning to die out. Read German books: no longer the remotest recollection that a technique, a plan of instruction, a will to mastery is required for thinking – that thinking has to be learned in the way dancing has to be learned, as a form of dancing.... Who among Germans still knows from experience that subtle thrill which the possession of intellectual light feet communicates to all the muscles! – A stiffly awkward air in intellectual matters, a clumsy hand in grasping – this is in so great a degree German that foreigners take it for the German nature in general. The German has no fingers for nuances.... That the Germans have so much as endured their philosophers, above all that most deformed conceptual cripple there has ever been, the great Kant, offers a good idea of German amenableness. For dancing in any form cannot be divorced from a noble education, being able to dance with the feet, with concepts, with words: do I still have to say that one has to be able to dance with the pen – that writing has to be learned? – But at this point I should become a complete enigma to German readers... Expeditions of an Untimely Man 1 My impossibles. – Seneca: or the toreador of virtue. – Rousseau: or the return to nature in *impuris naturalibus** – Schiller: or the Moral-Trumpeter of Säckingen.† – Dante: or the hyena which poetises on graves. – Kant: or cant as intelligible character. – Victor Hugo: or the Pharos in the Sea of Absurdity. – Liszt: or the virtuoso – with women.‡ – George Sand: or lactea ubertas,§ in English: the milch cow with the ‘fine style’. – Michelet: or enthusiasm which strips off the jacket. – Carlyle: or pessimism as indigestion. – John Stuart Mill: or offensive clarity. – Les frères de Goncourt: or the two Ajaxes struggling with Homer. Music by Offenbach. Zola: or ‘delight in stinking’. – 2 Renan. – Theology, or the corruption of reason by ‘original sin’ (Christianity). Witness: Renan, who, whenever he risks a more general Yes or No, misses the point with painful regularity. He would like, for instance, to

couple together la science and la noblesse; but la science belongs to democracy, that is patently obvious. He desires, with no little ambitiousness, to represent an aristocratism of the intellect: but at the same time he falls on his knees, and not only his knees, before its opposite, the *évangile des humbles*.... What avails all free thinking, modernity, mockery and wry-necked flexibility, if one is still Christian, Catholic and even priest in one's bowels! Renan possesses his mode of inventiveness, just like a Jesuit or a father confessor, in devising means of seduction; his intellectuality does not lack the broad priestly smirk – like all priests, he becomes dangerous only when he loves. Nobody can equal him in deadly adoration.... This spirit of Renan, an enervating spirit, is one fatality more for poor, sick, feeble-willed France. – 3 Sainte-Beuve. – Nothing masculine in him; full of petty sullen wrath against all masculine spirit. Roams about, delicate, inquisitive, bored, eavesdropping – fundamentally a woman, with a woman's revengefulness and a woman's sensuousness. As psychologist a genius of, *médiance*;* inexhaustibly rich in means for creating it; no one knows better how to mix poison with praise. Plebeian in the lowest instincts and related to Rousseau's ressentiment: consequently a romantic – for beneath all romantisme there grunts and thirsts Rousseau's instinct for revenge. A revolutionary, but kept tolerably in check by fear. Constrained in presence of everything possessing strength (public opinion, the Academy, the Court, even PortRoyal).† Embittered against all that is great in men and things, against all that believes in itself. Enough of a poet and semi-woman to feel greatness as power; constantly cringing, like the celebrated worm, because he constantly feels himself trodden on. As a critic without standards, steadiness or backbone, possessing the palate for a large variety of things of the cosmopolitan libertin but lacking the courage even to admit his libertinage. As a historian without philosophy, without the power of philosophical vision – for that reason rejecting, in all the main issues, the task of passing judgement, holding up 'objectivity' as a mask. He comports himself differently, however, towards questions in which a delicate, experienced taste is the highest court of appeal: there he really does have the courage for himself, takes pleasure in himself – there he is a master. – In some respects a preliminary form of Baudelaire. – 4 *The Imitatio Christi** is one of the books I cannot hold in my hand without experiencing a physiological resistance: it exhales a parfum of the 'eternal feminine'† for which one has to be French – or a Wagnerian.... This saint has a way of talking about love that makes even Parisiennes curious. – I am told that cunningest of Jesuits, A. Comte, who wanted to lead his Frenchmen to Rome via the *détour* of science, inspired himself with this book. I believe it: 'the religion of the heart'... 5 G. Eliot. – They have got rid of the Christian God, and now feel obliged to cling all the more firmly to Christian morality: that is English consistency, let us not blame it on little bluestockings à la Eliot. In England, in response to every little emancipation

from theology one has to reassert one's position in a fear-inspiring manner as a moral fanatic. That is the penance one pays there. – With us it is different. When one gives up Christian belief one thereby deprives oneself of the right to Christian morality. For the latter is absolutely not self-evident: one must make this point clear again and again, in spite of English shallowpates. Christianity is a system, a consistently thought out and complete view of things. If one breaks out of it a fundamental idea, the belief in God, one thereby breaks the whole thing to pieces: one has nothing of any consequence left in one's hands. Christianity presupposes that man does not know, cannot know what is good for him and what evil: he believes in God, who alone knows. Christian morality is a command: its origin is transcendental; it is beyond all criticism, all right to criticize; it possesses truth only if God is truth – it stands or falls with the belief in God. – If the English really do believe they will know, of their own accord, 'intuitively', what is good and evil; if they consequently think they no longer have need of Christianity as a guarantee of morality; that is merely the consequence of the ascendancy of Christian evaluation and an expression of the strength and depth of this ascendancy: so that the origin of English morality has been forgotten, so that the highly conditional nature of its right to exist is no longer felt. For the Englishman morality is not yet a problem... 6 George Sand. – I have read the first *Lettres d'un voyageur*: like everything deriving from Rousseau false, artificial, fustian, exaggerated. I cannot endure this colouredwallpaper style; nor the vulgar ambition to possess generous feelings. The worst, to be sure, is the female coquetting with male mannerisms, with the manners of illbred boys. – How cold she must have been withal, this insupportable authoress! She wound herself up like a clock – and wrote.... Cold, like Hugo, like Balzac, like all Romantics as soon as they started writing! And how complacently she liked to lie there, this prolific writing-cow, who had something German in the bad sense about her, like Rousseau her master, and who was in any case possible only with the decline of French taste! – But Renan respects her... 7 Moral code for psychologists. – No colportage psychology! Never observe for the sake of observing! That produces a false perspective, a squint, something forced and exaggerated. To experience from a desire to experience – that's no good. In experiencing, one must not look back towards oneself, or every glance becomes an 'evil eye'. A born psychologist instinctively guards against seeing for the sake of seeing; the same applies to the born painter. He never works 'from nature' – he leaves it to his instinct, his camera obscura, to sift and strain 'nature', the 'case', the 'experience'.... He is conscious only of the universal, the conclusion, the outcome: he knows nothing of that arbitrary abstraction from the individual case. – What will be the result if one does otherwise? Carries on colportage psychology in, for example, the manner of Parisian romanciers great and small? It is that sort of thing which as it were lies

in wait for reality, which brings a handful of curiosities home each evening.... But just see what finally emerges – a pile of daubs, a mosaic at best, in any event something put together, restless, flashy. The worst in this kind is achieved by the Goncourts: they never put three sentences together which are not simply painful to the eye, the psychologist's eye. – Nature, artistically considered, is no model. It exaggerates, it distorts, it leaves gaps. Nature is chance. To study 'from nature' seems to me a bad sign: it betrays subjection, weakness, fatalism – this lying in the dust before *petits faits** is unworthy of a complete artist. Seeing what is – that pertains to a different species of spirit, the anti-artistic, the prosaic. One has to know who one is... 8 Towards a psychology of the artist. – For art to exist, for any sort of aesthetic activity or perception to exist, a certain physiological precondition is indispensable: intoxication. Intoxication must first have heightened the excitability of the entire machine: no art results before that happens. All kinds of intoxication, however different their origin, have the power to do this: above all, the intoxication of sexual excitement, the oldest and most primitive form of intoxication. Likewise the intoxication which comes in the train of all great desires, all strong emotions; the intoxication of feasting, of contest, of the brave deed, of victory, of all extreme agitation; the intoxication of cruelty; intoxication in destruction; intoxication under certain meteorological influences, for example the intoxication of spring; or under the influence of narcotics; finally the intoxication of the will, the intoxication of an overloaded and distended will. – The essence of intoxication is the feeling of plenitude and increased energy. From out of this feeling one gives to things, one compels them to take, one rapes them – one calls this procedure idealizing. Let us get rid of a prejudice here: idealization does not consist, as is commonly believed, in a subtracting or deducting of the petty and secondary. A tremendous expulsion of the principal features rather is the decisive thing, so that thereupon the others too disappear. 9 In this condition one enriches everything out of one's own abundance: what one sees, what one desires, one sees swollen, pressing, strong, overladen with energy. The man in this condition transforms things until they mirror his power – until they are reflections of his perfection. This compulsion to transform into the perfect is – art. Even all that which he is not becomes for him none the less part of his joy in himself; in art, man takes delight in himself as perfection. – It would be permissible to imagine an antithetical condition, a specific anti-artisticity of instinct – a mode of being which impoverishes and attenuates things and makes them consumptive. And history is in fact rich in such anti-artists, in such starvelings of life, who necessarily have to take things to themselves, impoverish them, make them leaner. This is, for example, the case with the genuine Christian, with Pascal for example: a Christian who is at the same time an artist does not exist.... Let no one be childish and cite Raphael as an objection, or some homoeopathic Christian of the nineteenth century: Raphael

said Yes, Raphael did Yes, consequently Raphael was not a Christian... 10 What is the meaning of the antithetical concepts Apollinian and Dionysian, both conceived as forms of intoxication, which I introduced into aesthetics?* – Apollinian intoxication alerts above all the eye, so that it acquires power of vision. The painter, the sculptor, the epic poet are visionaries par excellence. In the Dionysian state, on the other hand, the entire emotional system is alerted and intensified: so that it discharges all its powers of representation, imitation, transfiguration, transmutation, every kind of mimicry and playacting, conjointly. The essential thing remains the facility of the metamorphosis, the incapacity not to react (– in a similar way to certain types of hysteric, who also assume any role at the slightest instigation). It is impossible for the Dionysian man not to understand any suggestion of whatever kind, he ignores no signal from the emotions, he possesses to the highest degree the instinct for understanding and divining, just as he possesses the art of communication to the highest degree. He enters into every skin, into every emotion; he is continually transforming himself. – Music, as we understand it today, is likewise a collective arousal and discharging of the emotions, but for all that only a vestige of a much fuller emotional world of expression, a mere residuum of Dionysian histrionicism. To make music possible as a separate art one had to immobilize a number of senses, above all the muscular sense (at least relatively: for all rhythm still speaks to our muscles to a certain extent): so that man no longer straightway imitates and represents bodily everything he feels. None the less, that is the true Dionysian normal condition, at least its original condition: music is the gradually-achieved specialization of this at the expense of the most closely related faculties. 11 The actor, the mime, the dancer, the musician, the lyric poet are fundamentally related in their instincts and essentially one, only gradually specialized and separated from one another – even to the point of opposition. The lyric poet stayed united longest with the musician, the actor with the dancer. – The architect represents neither a Dionysian nor an Apollinian condition: here it is the mighty act of will, the will which moves mountains, the intoxication of the strong will, which demands artistic expression. The most powerful men have always inspired the architects; the architect has always been influenced by power. Pride, victory over weight and gravity, the will to power, seek to render themselves visible in a building; architecture is a kind of rhetoric of power, now persuasive, even cajoling in form, now bluntly imperious. The highest feeling of power and security finds expression in that which possesses grand style. Power which no longer requires proving; which disdains to please; which is slow to answer; which is conscious of no witness around it; which lives oblivious of the existence of any opposition; which reposes in itself, fatalistic, a law among laws: that is what speaks of itself in the form of grand style. – 12 I have read the life of Thomas Carlyle, that unwitting and involuntary farce, that heroical-moralistical

interpretation of dyspepsia. – Carlyle, a man of strong words and attitudes, a rhetorician from necessity, continually agitated by the desire for a strong faith and the feeling of incapacity for it (– in this a typical Romantic!) The desire for a strong faith is not the proof of a strong faith, rather the opposite. If one has it one may permit oneself the beautiful luxury of scepticism: one is secure enough, firm enough, fixed enough for it. Carlyle deafens something within him by the fortissimo of his reverence for men of strong faith and by his rage against the less single-minded: he requires noise. A continual passionate dishonesty towards himself – that is his proprium, because of that he is and will remain interesting. – To be sure, in England he is admired precisely on account of his honesty.... Well, that is English; and, considering the English are the nation of consummate cant, even appropriate and not merely understandable. Fundamentally, Carlyle is an English atheist who wants to be honoured for not being one. 13 Emerson. – Much more enlightened, adventurous, multifarious, refined than Carlyle; above all, happier.... Such a man as instinctively feeds on pure ambrosia and leaves alone the indigestible in things. Compared with Carlyle a man of taste. – Carlyle, who had a great affection for him, nevertheless said of him: ‘He does not give us enough to bite on’: which may be truly said, but not to the detriment of Emerson. – Emerson possesses that good-natured and quickwitted cheerfulness that discourages all earnestness; he has absolutely no idea how old he is or how young he will be – he could say of himself, in the words of Lope de Vega: ‘yo me sucedo a mi mismo’.* His spirit is always finding reasons for being contented and even grateful; and now and then he verges on the cheerful transcendence of that worthy gentleman who, returning from an amorous rendezvous tamquam re bene gesta, said gratefully: ‘Ut desint vires, tamen est laudanda voluptas. ‘† 14 Anti-Darwin. – As regards the celebrated ‘struggle for life’, it seems to me for the present to have been rather asserted than proved. It does occur, but as the exception; the general aspect of life is not hunger and distress, but rather wealth, luxury, even absurd prodigality – where there is a struggle it is a struggle for power.... One should not mistake Malthus for nature. – Supposing, however, that this struggle exists – and it does indeed occur – its outcome is the reverse of that desired by the school of Darwin, of that which one ought perhaps to desire with them: namely, the defeat of the stronger, the more privileged, the fortunate exceptions. Species do not grow more perfect: the weaker dominate the strong again and again – the reason being they are the great majority, and they are also cleverer.... Darwin forgot the mind (– that is English!): the weak possess more mind.... To acquire mind one must need mind – one loses it when one no longer needs it. He who possesses strength divests himself of mind (– ‘let it depart!’ they think today in Germany, ‘– the Reich will still be ours.’...)* One will see that under mind I include foresight, patience, dissimulation, great self-control, and all that is mimicry (this last includes a great part of what is called virtue). 15

Psychologist's casuistry. This man is a human psychologist: what does he really study men for? He wants to gain little advantages over them, or big ones too – he is a politician!... This other man is also a human psychologist: and you say he wants nothing for himself, that he is 'impersonal'. Take a closer look! Perhaps he wants an even worse advantage: to feel himself superior to men, to have the right to look down on them, no longer to confuse himself with them. This 'impersonal' man is a despiser of men: and the former is a more humane species, which may even be clear from his appearance. At least he thinks himself equal to others, he involves himself with others... 16 The psychological taste of the Germans seems to me to be called in question by a whole series of instances which modesty forbids me to enumerate. There is one instance, however, which offers me a grand opportunity for establishing my thesis: I bear the Germans a grudge for their having blundered over Kant and his 'backdoor philosophy', as I call it – this was not the pattern of intellectual integrity. – Another thing I loathe to hear is an infamous 'and': the Germans say 'Goethe and Schiller' – I am afraid they say 'Schiller and Goethe'.... Don't people know this Schiller yet? – There are even worse 'ands'; I have heard 'Schopenhauer and Hartmann' with my own ears, though only among university professors, admittedly... 17 The most spiritual human beings, assuming they are the most courageous, also by experience by far the most painful tragedies: but it is precisely for this reason that they honour life, because it brings against them its most formidable weapons. 18 On the subject of 'intellectual conscience'. – Nothing seems to me to be rarer today than genuine hypocrisy. I greatly suspect that this plant finds the mild atmosphere of our culture unendurable. Hypocrisy has its place in the ages of strong belief: in which even when one is compelled to exhibit a different belief one does not abandon the belief one already has. Today one does abandon it; or, which is even more common, one acquires a second belief – one remains honest in any event. Beyond doubt, a very much larger number of convictions are possible today, than formerly: possible, that means permitted, that means harmless. That is the origin of self-tolerance. – Self-tolerance permits one to possess several convictions; these conciliate one another – they take care, as all the world does today, not to compromise themselves. How does one compromise oneself today? By being consistent. By going in a straight line. By being less than ambiguous. By being genuine.... I greatly fear that modern man is simply too indolent for certain vices: so that they are actually dying out. All evil which is dependent on strong will – and perhaps there is nothing evil without strength of will – is degenerating, in our tepid atmosphere, into virtue.... The few hypocrites I have known impersonated hypocrisy: they were, like virtually every tenth man nowadays, actors. – 19 Beautiful and ugly.* – Nothing is so conditional, let us say circumscribed, as our feeling for the beautiful. Anyone who tried to divorce it from man's pleasure in man would at once find the ground give way beneath

him. The 'beautiful in itself' is not even a concept, merely a phrase. In the beautiful, man sets himself up as the standard of perfection; in select cases he worships himself in it. A species cannot do otherwise than affirm itself alone in this manner. Its deepest instinct, that of selfpreservation and self-aggrandizement, is still visible in such sublimated forms. Man believes that the world itself is filled with beauty – he forgets that it is he who has created it. He alone has bestowed beauty upon the world – alas! only a very human, all too human beauty.... Man really mirrors himself in things, that which give him back his own reflection he considers beautiful: the judgement 'beautiful' is his conceit of his species.... For a tiny suspicion whispers into the sceptic's ear: is the world actually made beautiful because man finds it so? Man has humanized the world: that is all. But there is nothing, absolutely nothing, to guarantee to us that man constitutes the model for the beautiful. Who knows what figure he would cut in the eyes of a higher arbiter of taste? Perhaps a presumptuous one? perhaps even risible? perhaps a little arbitrary?... 'O Dionysos, divine one, why do you pull my ears?' Ariadne once asked her philosophical lover during one of those celebrated dialogues on Naxos.† 'I find a kind of humour in your ears, Ariadne: why are they not longer?' 20 Nothing is beautiful, only man: on this piece of naïvety rests all aesthetics, it is the first truth of aesthetics. Let us immediately add its second: nothing is ugly but degenerate man – the domain of aesthetic judgement is therewith defined. – Reckoned physiologically, everything ugly weakens and afflicts man. It recalls decay, danger, impotence; he actually suffers a loss of energy in its presence. The effect of the ugly can be measured with a dynamometer. Whenever man feels in any way depressed, he senses the proximity of something 'ugly'. His feeling of power, his will to power, his courage, his pride – they decline with the ugly, they increase with the beautiful.... In the one case as in the other we draw a conclusion: its premises have been accumulated in the instincts in tremendous abundance. The ugly is understood as a sign and symptom of degeneration: that which recalls degeneration, however remotely, produces in us the judgement 'ugly'. Every token of exhaustion, of heaviness, of age, of weariness, every kind of unfreedom, whether convulsive or paralytic, above all the smell, colour and shape of dissolution, of decomposition, though it be attenuated to the point of being no more than a symbol – all this calls forth the same reaction, the value judgement 'ugly'. A feeling of hatred then springs up; what is man then hating? But the answer admits of no doubt: the decline of his type. He hates then from out of the profoundest instinct of his species; there is horror, foresight, profundity, far-seeing vision in this hatred – it is the profoundest hatred there is. It is for its sake that art is profound... 21 Schopenhauer. – Schopenhauer, the last German of any consequence (– who is a European even like Goethe, like Hegel, like Heinrich Heine, and not merely a parochial, a 'national' one), is for a psychologist a case

of the first order: namely, as a mendacious attempt of genius to marshal, in aid of a nihilistic total devaluation of life, the very counter-instances, the great self-affirmations of the 'will to live', the exuberant forms of life. He interpreted in turn art, heroism, genius, beauty, grand sympathy, knowledge, the will to truth, tragedy, as phenomena consequent upon the 'denial' of or the thirst to deny the 'will' – the greatest piece of psychological falsecoinage in history, Christianity alone excepted. Looked at more closely he is in this merely the heir of the Christian interpretation: but with this difference, that he knew how to make what Christianity had rejected, the great cultural facts of mankind, and approve of them from a Christian, that is to say nihilistic, point of view (– namely as roads to 'redemption', as preliminary forms of 'redemption', as stimulants of the thirst for 'redemption' ...). 22 To take a particular instance: Schopenhauer speaks of beauty with a melancholy ardour – why, in the last resort? Because he sees it in a bridge upon which one may pass over, or acquire a thirst to pass over.... It is to him redemption from the 'will' for minutes at a time – it lures on to redemption for ever.... He values it especially as redeemer from the 'focus of the will', from sexuality – in beauty he sees the procreative impulse denied.... Singular saint! Someone contradicts you, and I fear it is nature. To what end is there beauty at all in the sounds, colours, odours, rhythmic movements of nature? what makes beauty appear? – Fortunately a philosopher also contradicts him. No less an authority than the divine Plato (– so Schopenhauer himself calls him) maintains a different thesis: that all beauty incites to procreation – that precisely this is the proprium of its effect, from the most sensual regions up into the most spiritual... 23 Plato goes further. He says, with an innocence for which one must be Greek and not 'Christian', that there would be no Platonic philosophy at all if Athens had not possessed such beautiful youths: it was the sight of them which first plunged the philosopher's soul into an erotic whirl and allowed it no rest until it had implanted the seed of all high things into so beautiful a soil. Another singular saint! – one doesn't believe one's ears, even supposing one believed Plato. One sees, at least, that philosophizing was different in Athens, above all public. Nothing is less Greek than the conceptual cobweb-spinning of a hermit, amor intellectualis dei* in the manner of Spinoza. Philosophy in the manner of Plato should rather be defined as an erotic contest, as a further development and inward intensification of the old agonal gymnastics and their presuppositions.... What finally emerged from this philosophical eroticism of Plato? A new artistic form of the Greek agon, dialectics. – I further recall, opposing Schopenhauer and to the honour of Plato, that the entire higher culture and literature of classical France also grew up on the soil of sexual interest. One may seek everywhere in it for gallantry, sensuality, sexual contest, 'woman' – one will never seek in vain... 24 L'art pour l'art.† – The struggle against purpose in art is always a struggle against the moralizing tendency in art, against the subordination of art to

morality. L'art pour l'art means: 'the devil take morality!' – But this very hostility betrays that moral prejudice is still dominant. When one has excluded from art the purpose of moral preaching and human improvement it by no means follows that art is completely purposeless, goalless, meaningless, in short l'art pour l'art – a snake biting its own tail. 'Rather no purpose at all than a moral purpose!' – thus speaks mere passion. A psychologist asks on the other hand: what does all art do? does it not praise? does it not glorify? does it not select? does it not highlight? By doing all this it strengthens or weakens certain valuations.... Is this no more than an incidental? an accident? Something in which the instinct of the artist has no part whatever? Or is it not rather the prerequisite for the artist's being an artist at all.... Is his basic instinct directed towards art, or is it not rather directed towards the meaning of art, which is life? towards a desideratum of life? – Art is the great stimulus to life: how could it be thought purposeless, aimless, l'art pour l'art? One question remains: art also brings to light much that is ugly, hard, questionable in life – does it not thereby seem to suffer from life? – And there have indeed been philosophers who lent it this meaning: Schopenhauer taught that the whole object of art was to 'liberate from the will', and he revered tragedy because its greatest function was to 'dispose one to resignation'. – But this – as I have already intimated – is a pessimist's perspective and 'evil eye' – : one must appeal to the artists themselves. What does the tragic artist communicate of himself? Does he not display precisely the condition of fearlessness in the face of the fearsome and questionable? – This condition itself is a high desideratum: he who knows it bestows on it the highest honours. He communicates it, he has to communicate it if he is an artist, a genius of communication. Bravery and composure in the face of a powerful enemy, great hardship, a problem that arouses aversion – it is this victorious condition which the tragic artist singles out, which he glorifies. In the face of tragedy the warlike in our soul celebrates its Saturnalias; whoever is accustomed to suffering, whoever seeks out suffering, the heroic man extols his existence by means of tragedy – for him alone does the tragic poet pour this draught of sweetest cruelty. – 25 To put up with men, to keep open house in one's heart – this is liberal, but no more than liberal. One knows hearts which are capable of noble hospitality, which have curtained windows and closed shutters: they keep their best rooms empty. Why do they so? – Because they await guests with whom one does not have to 'put up'... 26 We no longer have a sufficiently high estimate of ourselves when we communicate. Our true experiences are not garrulous. They could not communicate themselves if they wanted to: they lack words. We have already grown beyond whatever we have words for. In all talking there lies a grain of contempt. Speech, it seems, was devised only for the average, medium, communicable. The speaker has already vulgarized himself by speaking. – From a moral code for deaf-mutes and other philosophers. 27 'This

picture is enchanting fair!’*... The literary woman, unsatisfied, agitated, desolate in heart and entrails, listening every minute with painful curiosity to the imperative which whispers from the depths of her organism ‘aut liberi aut libri’:† the literary woman, cultured enough to understand the voice of nature even when it speaks Latin, and on the other hand vain enough and enough of a goose to say secretly to herself in French ‘je me verrai, je me lirai, je m’extasierai et je dirai: Possible, que j’aie eu tant d’esprit?’...‡ 28 The ‘impersonal’ take the floor. – ‘We find nothing easier than being wise, patient, superior. We drip with the oil of forbearance and sympathy, we are absurdly just, we forgive everything. For that very reason we ought to discipline ourselves a little; for that very reason we ought to cultivate a little emotion, a little emotional vice, from time to time. It may be hard for us; and among ourselves we may perhaps laugh at the appearance we thus present. But what of that! We no longer have any other mode of self-overcoming available to us: this is our asceticism, our penance’. ... Becoming personal – the virtue of the ‘impersonal’ ... 29 From a doctorate exam. – ‘What is the task of all higher education?’ – To turn a man into a machine. – ‘By what means?’ – He has to learn how to feel bored. – ‘How is that achieved?’ – Through the concept of duty. – ‘Who is his model?’ – The philologist: he teaches how to grind.* – ‘Who is the perfect man?’ – The civil servant. – ‘Which philosophy provides the best formula for the civil servant?’ – Kant’s: the civil servant as thing in itself set as judge over the civil servant as appearance. – 30 The right to stupidity. – The wearied and slow-breathing worker, good-natured, letting things take their course: this typical figure, who is now, in the Age of Work (and of the ‘Reich!’), encountered in all classes of society, is today laying claim even to art, including the book and above all the journal – how much more to the beauties of nature, to Italy.... The man of the evening, with the ‘wild instincts lulled to sleep’ of which Faust speaks.† requires the health resort, the seaside, the glaciers, Bayreuth.‡... In ages like this, art has a right to pure folly§ – as a kind of holiday for the spirit, the wits and the heart. Wagner understood that. Pure folly is a restorative... 31 Another problem of diet. – The means by which Julius Caesar defended himself against sickness and headache: tremendous marches, the simplest form of living, uninterrupted sojourn in the open air, continuous toil – these, broadly speaking, are the universal preservative and protective measures against the extreme vulnerability of that subtle machine working at the highest pressure which is called genius. – 32 The immoralist speaks. – Nothing offends a philosopher’s taste more than man when he expresses desires.... When the philosopher sees man only in his activity, when he sees this bravest, cunningest, toughest of animals straying even into labyrinthine calamities, how admirable man seems to him! He encourages him.... But the philosopher despises desiring man, and the ‘desirable’ man too – he despises all the desiderata, all the ideals of man. If a philosopher could be a nihilist, he would

be one because he finds nothingness behind all the ideals of men. Or not even nothingness merely – but only the worthless, the absurd, the sick, the cowardly, the weary, dregs of all kinds from the cup of his life after he has drained it.... How does it come about that man, so admirable as a reality, deserves no respect when he expresses desires? Does he have to atone for being so able as a reality? Does he have to compensate for his activity, for the exertion of will and hand involved in all activity, with a relaxation in the imaginary and absurd? – The history of his desiderata has hitherto been the *partie honteuse** of man: one should take care not to read too long in it. What justifies man is his reality – it will justify him eternally. How much more valuable an actual man is compared with any sort of merely desired, dreamed of, odious lie of a man? with any sort of ideal man?... And it is only the ideal man who offends the philosopher's taste.

33 The natural value of egoism. – The value of egoism depends on the physiological value of him who possesses it: it can be very valuable, it can be worthless and contemptible. Every individual may be regarded as representing the ascending or descending line of life. When one has decided which, one has thereby established a canon for the value of his egoism. If he represents the ascending line his value is in fact extraordinary – and for the sake of the life-collective, which with him takes a step forward, the care expended on his preservation, on the creation of optimum conditions for him, may even be extreme. For the individual, the 'single man', as people and philosophers have hitherto understood him, is an error: he does not constitute a separate entity, an atom, a 'link in the chain', something merely inherited from the past – he constitutes the entire single line 'man' up to and including himself.... If he represents the descending development, decay, chronic degeneration, sickening (– sickness is, broadly speaking, already a phenomenon consequent upon decay, not the cause of it), then he can be accorded little value, and elementary fairness demands that he takes away as little as possible from the well-constituted. He is not better than a parasite on them...

34 Christian and anarchist. – When the anarchist, as the mouthpiece of declining strata of society, demands with righteous indignation 'his rights', 'justice', 'equal rights', he is only acting under the influence of his want of culture, which prevents his understanding why he is really suffering – in what respect he is impoverished, in life.... A cause-creating drive is powerful within him: someone must be to blame for his feeling vile.... His 'righteous indignation' itself already does him good; every poor devil finds pleasure in scolding – it gives him a little of the intoxication of power. Even complaining and wailing can give life a charm for the sake of which one endures it: there is a small dose of revenge in every complaint, one reproaches those who are different for one's feeling vile, sometimes even with one's being vile, as if they had perpetrated an injustice or possessed an impermissible privilege. 'If I am canaille, you ought to be so too': on the basis of this logic one makes

revolutions. – Complaining is never of any use: it comes from weakness. Whether one attributes one's feeling vile to others or to oneself – the Socialist does the former, the Christian for example the latter – makes no essential difference. What is common to both, and unworthy in both, is that someone has to be to blame for the fact that one suffers – in short, that the sufferer prescribes for himself the honey of revenge as a medicine for his suffering. The objectives of this thirst for revenge as a thirst for pleasure vary according to circumstances: the sufferer finds occasions everywhere for cooling his petty revengefulness – if he is a Christian, to say it again, he finds them in himself.... The Christian and the anarchist – both are *décadents*. – And when the Christian condemns, calumniates and befouls the 'world', he does so from the same instinct from which the Socialist worker condemns, calumniates and befouls society: even the 'Last Judgement' is still the sweet consolation of revenge – the revolution, such as the Socialist worker too anticipates, only conceived of as somewhat more distant.... Even the 'Beyond' – why a Beyond if not as a means of befouling the Here-and-Now?... 35 A criticism of *décadence* morality. – An 'altruistic' morality, a morality under which egoism languishes – is under all circumstances a bad sign. This applies to individuals, it applies especially to peoples. The best are lacking when egoism begins to be lacking. To choose what is harmful to oneself, to be attracted by 'disinterested' motives, almost constitutes the formula for *décadence*. 'Not to seek one's own advantage' – that is merely a moral figleaf for a quite different, namely physiological fact: 'I no longer know how to find my advantage'.... Disgregation of the instincts! – Man is finished when he becomes altruistic. – Instead of saying simply 'I am no longer worth anything', the moral lie in the mouth of the *décadent* says: 'Nothing is worth anything – life is not worth anything'.... Such a judgement represents, after all, a grave danger, it is contagious – on the utterly morbid soil of society it soon grows up luxuriously, now in the form of religion (Christianity), now in that of philosophy (Schopenhauerism). In some circumstances the vapours of such a poison-tree jungle sprung up out of putrefaction can poison life for years ahead, for thousands of years ahead... 36 A moral code for physicians. – The invalid is a parasite on society. In a certain state it is indecent to go on living. To vegetate on in cowardly dependence on physicians and medicaments after the meaning of life, the right to life, has been lost ought to entail the profound contempt of society. Physicians, in their turn, ought to be the communicators of this contempt – not prescriptions, but every day a fresh dose of disgust with their patients.... To create a new responsibility, that of the physician, in all cases in which the highest interest of life, of ascending life, demands the most ruthless suppression and sequestration of degenerating life – for example in determining the right to reproduce, the right to be born, the right to live.... To die proudly when it is no longer possible to live proudly. Death of one's own free choice, death at the

proper time, with a clear head and with joyfulness, consummated in the midst of children and witnesses: so that an actual leave-taking is possible while he who is leaving is still there, likewise an actual evaluation of what has been desired and what achieved in life, an adding-up of life – all of this in contrast to the pitiable and horrible comedy Christianity has made of the hour of death. One should never forget of Christianity that it has abused the weakness of the dying to commit conscience-rape and even the mode of death to formulate value judgements on men and the past! – Here, every cowardice of prejudice notwithstanding, it is above all a question of establishing the correct, that is physiological evaluation of so-called natural death: which is, after all, also only an ‘unnatural’ death, an act of suicide. One perishes by no one but oneself. Only ‘natural’ death is death for the most contemptible reasons, an unfree death, a death at the wrong time, a coward’s death. From love of life one ought to desire to die differently from this: freely, consciously, not accidentally, not suddenly overtaken. ... Finally, a piece of advice for messieurs the pessimists and other *décadents*. We have no power to prevent ourselves being born: but we can rectify this error – for it is sometimes an error. When one does away with oneself one does the most estimable thing possible: one thereby almost deserves to live.... Society – what am I saying! life itself derives more advantage from that than from any sort of ‘life’ spent in renunciation, green-sickness and other virtues – one has freed others from having to endure one’s sight, one has removed an objection from life.... Pessimism, *pur, vert** proves itself only by the self-negation of messieurs the pessimists: one must take their logic a step further, and not deny life merely in ‘will and idea’, as Schopenhauer did – one must first of all deny Schopenhauer.... Pessimism, by the by, however contagious it may be, nevertheless does not add to the morbidity of an age or a race in general: it is the expression of this morbidity. One succumbs to it as one succumbs to cholera: one’s constitution must already be sufficiently morbid. Pessimism does not of itself make a single additional *décadent*, I recall that statistics show that the years in which cholera rages do not differ from other years in the total number of deaths. 37 Whether we have grown more moral. – As was only to be expected, the whole ferocity of the moral stupidity which, as is well known, is considered morality as such in Germany, has launched itself against my concept ‘beyond good and evil’: I could tell some pretty stories about it. Above all, I was invited to reflect on the ‘undeniable superiority’ of our age in moral judgement, our real advance in this respect: compared with us, a Cesare Borgia was certainly not to be set up as a ‘higher man’, as a kind of superman, in the way I set him up.... A Swiss editor, that of the ‘*Bund*’, went so far – not without expressing his admiration of the courage for so hazardous an enterprise – as to ‘understand’ that the meaning of my work lay in a proposal to abolish all decent feeling. Much obliged!* – by way of reply I permit myself to raise the question whether we

have really grown more moral. That all the world believes so is already an objection to it.... We modern men, very delicate, very vulnerable and paying and receiving consideration in a hundred ways, imagine in fact that this sensitive humanity which we represent, this achieved unanimity in forbearance, in readiness to help, in mutual trust, is a positive advance, that with this we have gone far beyond the men of the Renaissance. But every age thinks in this way, has to think in this way. What is certain is that we would not dare to place ourselves in Renaissance circumstances, or even imagine ourselves in them: our nerves could not endure that reality, not to speak of our muscles. This incapacity, however, demonstrates, not an advance, but only a different, a more belated constitution, a weaker, more delicate, more vulnerable one, out of which is necessarily engendered a morality which is full of consideration. If we think away our delicacy and belatedness, our physiological ageing, then our morality of 'humanization' too loses its value at once – no morality has any value in itself – : we would even despise it. On the other hand, let us be in no doubt that we modern men, with our thick padding of humanity which dislikes to give the slightest offence, would provide the contemporaries of Cesare Borgia with a side-splitting comedy. We are, in fact, involuntarily funny beyond all measure, we with our modern 'virtues'.... The decay of our hostile and mistrust-arousing instincts – and that is what constitutes our 'advance' – represents only one of the effects attending our general decay of vitality: it costs a hundred times more effort, more foresight, to preserve so dependent, so late an existence as we are. Here everyone helps everyone else, here everyone is to a certain degree an invalid and everyone a nurse. This is then called 'virtue' – : among men who knew a different kind of life, a fuller, more prodigal, more overflowing life, it would be called something else: 'cowardice', perhaps, 'pitiableness', 'old woman's morality'.... Our softening of customs – this is my thesis, my innovation if you like – is a consequence of decline; stern and frightful customs can, conversely, be a consequence of a superabundance of life. For in the latter case much may be risked, much demanded and much squandered. What was formerly a spice of life would be poison to us.... We are likewise too old, too belated, to be capable of indifference –also a form of strength: our morality of pity, against which I was the first to warn, that which one might call l'impressionisme morale, is one more expression of the physiological overexcitability pertaining to everything *décadent*. That movement which with Schopenhauer's morality of pity attempted to present itself as scientific – a very unsuccessful attempt! – is the actual *décadence* movement in morality; as such it is profoundly related to Christian morality. Strong ages, noble cultures, see in pity, in 'love of one's neighbour', in a lack of self and self-reliance, something contemptible. – Ages are to be assessed according to their positive forces – and by this assessment the age of the Renaissance, so prodigal and so fateful, appears

as the last great age, and we, we moderns with our anxious care for ourselves and love of our neighbour, with our virtues of work, of unpretentiousness, of fair play, of scientificity – acquisitive, economical, machine-minded – appear as a weak age.... Our virtues are conditioned, are demanded by our weakness.... ‘Equality’, a certain actual rendering similar of which the theory of ‘equal rights’ is only the expression, belongs essentially to decline: the chasm between man and man, class and class, the multiplicity of types, the will to be oneself, to stand out – that which I call pathos of distance – characterizes every strong age. The tension, the range between the extremes is today growing less and less – the extremes themselves are finally obliterated to the point of similarity.... All our political theories and state constitutions, the ‘German Reich’ certainly not excluded, are consequences, necessary effects of decline; the unconscious influence of *décadence* has gained ascendancy even over the ideals of certain of the sciences. My objection to the whole of sociology in England and France is that it knows from experience only the decaying forms of society and takes its own decaying instincts with perfect innocence as the norm of sociological value judgement. Declining life, the diminution of all organizing power, that is to say the power of separating, of opening up chasms, of ranking above and below, formulates itself in the sociology of today as the ideal.... Our Socialists are *décadents*, but Mr Herbert Spencer is also a *décadent* – he sees in the victory of altruism something desirable!... 38 My conception of freedom. – The value of a thing sometimes lies not in what one attains with it, but in what one pays for it – what it costs us. I give an example. Liberal institutions immediately cease to be liberal as soon as they are attained: subsequently there is nothing more thoroughly harmful to freedom than liberal institutions. One knows, indeed, what they bring about: they undermine the will to power, they are the levelling of mountain and valley exalted to a moral principle, they make small, cowardly and smug – it is the herd animal which triumphs with them every time. Liberalism: in plain words, reduction to the herd animal.... As long as they are still being fought for, these same institutions produce quite different effects; they then in fact promote freedom mightily. Viewed more closely, it is war which produces these effects, war for liberal institutions which as war permits the illiberal instincts to endure. And war is a training in freedom. For what is freedom? That one has the will to self-responsibility. That one preserves the distance which divides us. That one has become more indifferent to hardship, toil, privation, even to life. That one is ready to sacrifice men to one’s cause, oneself not excepted. Freedom means that the manly instincts that delight in war and victory have gained mastery over the other instincts – for example, over the instinct for ‘happiness’. The man who has become free – and how much more the mind that has become free – spurns the contemptible sort of well-being dreamed of by shopkeepers, Christians, cows, women, Englishmen and other democrats. The

free man is a warrior. – How is freedom measured, in individuals as in nations? By the resistance which has to be overcome, by the effort it costs to stay aloft. One would have to seek the highest type of free man where the greatest resistance is constantly being overcome: five steps from tyranny, near the threshold of the danger of servitude. This is true psychologically when one understands by ‘tyrants’ pitiless and dreadful instincts, to combat which demands the maximum of authority and discipline towards oneself – finest type Julius Caesar –; it is also true politically: one has only to look at history. The nations which were worth something, which became worth something, never became so under liberal institutions: it was great danger which made of them something deserving reverence, danger which first teaches us to know our resources, our virtues, our shield and spear, our spirit – which compels us to be strong.... First principle: one must need strength, otherwise one will never have it. – Those great forcing-houses for strong human beings, for the strongest kind there has ever been, the aristocratic communities of the pattern of Rome and Venice, understood freedom in precisely the sense which I understand the word ‘freedom’: as something one has and does not have, something one wants, something one conquers... 39 Criticism of modernity. – Our institutions are no longer fit for anything: everyone is unanimous about that. But the fault lies not in them but in us. Having lost all the instincts out of which institutions grow, we are losing the institutions themselves, because we are no longer fit for them. Democracy has always been the declining form of the power to organize: I have already, in *Human, All Too Human*, characterized modern democracy, together with its imperfect manifestations such as the ‘German Reich’, as the decaying form of the state. For institutions to exist there must exist the kind of will, instinct, imperative which is anti-liberal to the point of malice: the will to tradition, to authority, to centuries-long responsibility, to solidarity between succeeding generations backwards and forwards in infinitum. If this will is present, there is established something such as the Imperium Romanum: or such as Russia, the only power today which has durability in it, which can wait, which can still promise something – Russia, the antithesis of that pitiable European petty-state politics and nervousness which with the foundation of the German Reich has entered a critical phase.... The entire West has lost those instincts out of which institutions grow, out of which the future grows: perhaps nothing goes so much against the grain of its ‘modern spirit’ as this. One lives for today, one lives very fast – one lives very irresponsibly: it is precisely this which one calls ‘freedom’. That which makes institutions institutions is despised, hated, rejected: whenever the word ‘authority’ is so much as heard one believes oneself in danger of a new slavery. The décadence in the valuating instinct of our politicians, our political parties, goes so deep that they instinctively prefer that which leads to dissolution, that which hastens the end.... Witness modern marriage. It is obvious that all

sense has gone out of modern marriage: which is, however, no objection to marriage but to modernity. The rationale of marriage lay in the legal sole responsibility of the man: marriage thereby had a centre of gravity, whereas now it limps with both legs. The rationale of marriage lay in its indissolubility in principle: it thereby acquired an accent which could make itself heard against the accidents of feeling, passion and the moment. It lay likewise in the responsibility of the families for the selection of mates. With the increasing indulgence of love matches one has simply eliminated the foundation of marriage, that alone which makes it an institution. One never establishes an institution on the basis of an idiosyncrasy, one does not, as aforesaid, establish marriage on the basis of 'love' – one establishes it on the basis of the sexual drive, the drive to own property (wife and child considered as property), the drive to dominate which continually organizes the smallest type of domain, the family, which needs children and heirs so as to retain, in a physiological sense as well, an achieved measure of power, influence, wealth, so as to prepare for protracted tasks, for a solidarity of instinct between the centuries. Marriage as an institution already includes in itself the affirmation of the largest, the most enduring form of organization: if society as a whole cannot stand security for itself to the most distant generations, then marriage has really no meaning. – Modern marriage has lost its meaning – consequently it is being abolished. 40 The labour question. – The stupidity, fundamentally the instinct degeneration which is the cause of every stupidity today, lies in the existence of a labour question at all. About certain things one does not ask questions: first imperative of instinct. – I simply cannot see what one wishes to do with the European worker now one has made a question of him. He finds himself far too well placed not to go on asking for more, or to ask more and more impudently. After all, he has the great majority on his side. There is absolutely no hope left that a modest and self-sufficient kind of human being, a type of Chinaman, should here form itself into a class: and this would have been sensible, this was actually a necessity. What has one done? – Everything designed to nip in the bud even the prerequisites for it – through the most irresponsible thoughtlessness one has totally destroyed the instincts by virtue of which the worker becomes possible as a class, possible for himself. The worker has been made liable for military service, he has been allowed to form unions and to vote: no wonder the worker already feels his existence to be a state of distress (expressed in moral terms as a state of injustice). But what does one want? – to ask it again. If one wills an end, one must also will the means to it: if one wants slaves, one is a fool if one educates them to be masters. – 41 'Freedom as I do not mean it.*...' – In times like these, to have to rely on one's instincts is one fatality more. These instincts contradict, disturb and destroy one another; I have already defined the modern as physiological self-contradiction. The rationale of education would seem to require that at least one of these

instinctsystems should be paralysed beneath an iron pressure, so as to permit another to come into force, become strong, become master. Today the only way of making the individual possible would be by pruning him: possible, that is to say complete.... The reverse is what actually happens: the claim to independence, to free development, to *laissez aller*, is advanced most heatedly by precisely those for whom no curb could be too strong – this applies in politics, it applies in art. But this is a symptom of *décadence*: our modern concept ‘freedom’ is one more proof of degeneration of instinct. – 42 Where faith is needed. – Nothing is rarer among moralists and saints than integrity; perhaps they say the opposite, perhaps they even believe it. For when faith is more useful, effective, convincing than conscious hypocrisy, hypocrisy instinctively and forthwith becomes innocent: first principle for the understanding of great saints. In the case of philosophers too, a different kind of saint, their entire trade demands that they concede only certain truths: namely those through which their trade receives public sanction – in Kantian terms, truths of practical reason. They know what they have to prove, they are practical in that – they recognize one another by their agreement over ‘truths’. – ‘Thou shalt not lie’ – in plain words: take care, philosopher, not to tell the truth... 43 In the ear of the Conservatives. – What was formerly not known, what is known today or could be known – a reversion, a turning back in any sense and to any degree, is quite impossible. We physiologists at least know that. But all priests and moralists have believed it was possible – they have wanted to take mankind back, force it back, to an earlier standard of virtue. Morality has always been a bed of Procrustes. Even politicians have in this matter imitated the preachers of virtue: even today there are parties whose goal is a dream of the crabwise retrogression of all things. But no one is free to be a crab. There is nothing for it: one has to go forward, which is to say step by step further into *décadence* (– this is my definition of modern ‘progress’...). One can retard this development and, through retardation, dam and gather up degeneration itself and make it more vehement and sudden: more one cannot do. – 44 My conception of the genius. – Great men, like great epochs, are explosive material in whom tremendous energy has been accumulated; their prerequisite has always been, historically and physiologically, that a protracted assembling, accumulating, economizing and preserving has preceded them – that there has been no explosion for a long time. If the tension in the mass has grown too great the merest accidental stimulus suffices to call the ‘genius’, the ‘deed’, the great destiny, into the world. Of what account then are circumstances, the epoch, the *Zeitgeist*, public opinion! – Take the case of Napoleon. The France of the Revolution, and even more preRevolution France, would have brought forth the type antithetical to Napoleon: it did bring it forth, moreover. And because Napoleon was different, the heir of a stronger, longer, older civilization than that which was going up in dust and smoke in France, he became master here, he

alone was master here. Great human beings are necessary, the epoch in which they appear is accidental; that they almost always become master of their epoch is only because they are stronger, because they are older, because a longer assembling of force has preceded them. The relationship between a genius and his epoch is the same as that between strong and weak, and as that between old and young: the epoch is always relatively much younger, less substantial, more immature, less sure of itself, more childish. – That they have very different ideas on this subject in France today (in Germany too, but that is of no consequence), that there the theory of milieu, a real neurotic's theory, has become sacrosanct and almost scientific and finds credence even among physiologists – that fact has an 'ill odour' and gives one sadly to think. – The same ideas are believed in England too, but no one will lose any sleep over that. The Englishman has only two possible ways of coming to terms with the genius and 'great man': either the democratic way in the manner of Buckle or the religious way in the manner of Carlyle. – The danger which lies in great human beings and great epochs is extraordinary; sterility, exhaustion of every kind follow in their footsteps. The great human being is a terminus; the great epoch, the Renaissance for example, is a terminus. The genius – in his works, in his deeds – is necessarily a prodigal: his greatness lies in the fact that he expends himself.... The instinct of self-preservation is as it were suspended; the overwhelming pressure of the energies which emanate from him forbids him any such care and prudence. One calls this 'sacrifice'; one praises his 'heroism' therein, his indifference to his own interests, his devotion to an idea, a great cause, a fatherland: all misunderstandings.... He flows out, he overflows, he uses himself up, he does not spare himself – with inevitability, fatefully, involuntarily, as a river's bursting its banks is involuntary. But because one owes a great deal to such explosive beings one has bestowed a great deal upon them in return, for example a species of higher morality.... For that is the nature of human gratitude: it misunderstands its benefactors. – 45 The criminal and what is related to him. – The criminal type is the type of the strong human being under unfavourable conditions, a strong human being made sick. What he lacks is the wilderness, a certain freer and more perilous nature and form of existence in which all that is attack and defence in the instinct of the strong human being comes into its own. His virtues have been excommunicated by society; the liveliest drives within him forthwith blend with the depressive emotions, with suspicion, fear, dishonour. But this is almost the recipe for physiological degeneration. He who has to do in secret what he does best and most likes to do, with protracted tension, caution, slyness, becomes anaemic; and because he has never harvested anything from his instincts but danger, persecution, disaster, his feelings too turn against these instincts – he feels them to be a fatality. It is society, our tame, mediocre, gelded society, in which a human being raised in nature, who comes from the mountains or from adventures

of the sea, necessarily degenerates into a criminal. Or almost necessarily: for there are cases in which such a human being proves stronger than society: the Corsican Napoleon is the most famous case. In regard to the problem before us the testimony of Dostoyevsky is of importance – Dostoyevsky, the only psychologist, by the way, from whom I had anything to learn: he is one of the happiest accidents of my life, even more so than my discovery of Stendhal. This profound human being, who was ten times justified in despising the superficial Germans, found the Siberian convicts in whose midst he lived for a long time, nothing but the worst criminals for whom no return to society was possible, very different from what he himself had expected – he found them to be carved out of about the best, hardest and most valuable timber growing anywhere on Russian soil. Let us generalize the case of the criminal: let us think of natures which, for whatever reason, lack public approval, which know they are not considered beneficial or useful, that Chandala feeling that one is considered not an equal but as thrust out, as unworthy, as a source of pollution. The colour of the subterranean is on the thoughts and actions of such natures; everything in them becomes paler than in those upon whose existence the light of day reposes. But virtually every form of existence which we treat with distinction today formerly lived in this semi-gravelike atmosphere: the scientific nature, the artist, the genius, the free spirit, the actor, the merchant, the great discoverer.... As long as the priest was considered the highest type every valuable kind of human being was disvalued. ... The time is coming – I promise it – when he will be considered the lowest, as our Chandala, as the most mendacious, as the most indecent kind of human being. ... I draw attention to the fact that even now, under the mildest rule of custom which has ever obtained on earth or at any rate in Europe, every kind of apartness, every protracted, all too protracted keeping under, every uncommon, untransparent form of existence, brings men close to that type of which the criminal is the perfection. All innovators of the spirit bear for a time the pallid, fatalistic sign of the Chandala on their brow: not because they are felt to be so, but because they themselves feel the terrible chasm which divides them from all that is traditional and held in honour. Almost every genius knows as one of the phases of his development the ‘Catilinarian existence’, a feeling of hatred, revengefulness and revolt against everything which already is, which is no longer becoming.... Catiline – the antecedent form of every Caesar. – 46 Here is the prospect free.* – When a philosopher keeps silent, it can be loftiness of soul; when he contradicts himself, it can be love; a politeness which tells lies is possible in men of knowledge. Not without subtlety was it said: *il est indigne des grands coeurs de répandre le trouble qu’ils ressentent*:† only one has to add that not to fear the unworthiest things can likewise be greatness of soul. A woman who loves sacrifices her honour; a man of knowledge who ‘loves’ sacrifices perhaps his humanity; a god who loved became a Jew... 47 Beauty no

accident. – Even the beauty of a race or a family, the charm and benevolence of their whole demeanour, is earned by labour: like genius, it is the final result of the accumulatory labour of generations. One must have made great sacrifices to good taste, one must for its sake have done many things, left many things undone – the French seventeenth century is admirable in both – one must have possessed in it a selective principle in respect of one's society, residence, dress, sexual gratification, one must have preferred beauty to advantage, habit, opinion, indolence. Supreme rule of conduct: even when alone one must not 'let oneself go'. – Good things are costly beyond measure: and the law still holds that he who has them is different from him who obtains them. Everything good is inheritance: what is not inherited is imperfect, is a beginning.... In Athens at the time of Cicero, who expressed his surprise at it, the men and youths were of far superior beauty to the women: but what labour and exertion in the service of beauty the male sex of that place had for centuries demanded of themselves! – For one must not mistake the method involved here: a mere disciplining of thoughts and feelings is virtually nothing (– here lies the great mistake of German culture, which is totally illusory): one first has to convince the body. The strict maintenance of a significant and select demeanour, an obligation to live only among men who do not 'let themselves go', completely suffices for becoming significant and select: in two or three generations everything is already internalized. It is decisive for the fortune of nations and of mankind that one should inaugurate culture in the right place – not in the 'soul' (as has been the fateful superstition of priests and quasi-priests): the right place is the body, demeanour, diet, physiology: the rest follows.... This is why the Greeks remain the supreme cultural event of history – they knew, they did what needed to be done; Christianity, which despised the body, has up till now been mankind's greatest misfortune. – 48 Progress in my sense. – I too speak of a 'return to nature', although it is not really a going-back but a going-up – up into a high, free, even frightful nature and naturalness, such as plays with great tasks, is permitted to play with them.... To speak in a parable: Napoleon was a piece of 'return to nature' as I understand it (for example in rebus tacticis* even more, as military men know, in strategy). – But Rousseau – where did he really want to return to? Rousseau, this first modern man, idealist, and canaille in one person; who needed moral 'dignity' in order to endure his own aspect; sick with unbridled vanity and unbridled self-contempt. Even this abortion recumbent on the threshold of the new age wanted a 'return to nature' – where, to ask it again, did Rousseau want to return to? – I hate Rousseau even in the Revolution: it is the world-historical expression of this duplicity of idealist and canaille. The bloody farce enacted by this Revolution, its 'immorality', does not concern me much: what I hate is its Rousseauesque morality – the so-called 'truths' of the Revolution through which it is still an active force and persuades everything

shallow and mediocre over to its side. The doctrine of equality!... But there exists no more poisonous poison: for it seems to be preached by justice itself, while it is the termination of justice.... 'Equality for equals, inequality for unequals' – that would be the true voice of justice: and, what follows from it, 'Never make equal what is unequal'. – That such dreadful and bloody happenings have surrounded this doctrine of equality has given this 'modern idea' par excellence a kind of glory and lurid glow, so that the Revolution as a spectacle has seduced even the noblest spirits. That is, however, no reason for esteeming it any more highly. – I see only one who experienced it as it has to be experienced – with disgust – Goethe... 49 Goethe – not a German event but a European one: a grand attempt to overcome the eighteenth century through a return to nature, through a going-up to the naturalness of the Renaissance, a kind of self-overcoming on the part of that century. – He bore within him its strongest instincts: sentimentality, nature-idolatry, the anti-historical, the idealistic, the unreal and revolutionary (– the last is only a form of the unreal). He called to his aid history, the natural sciences, antiquity, likewise Spinoza, above all practical activity; he surrounded himself with nothing but closed horizons; he did not sever himself from life, he placed himself within it; nothing could discourage him and he took as much as possible upon himself, above himself, within himself. What he aspired to was totality; he strove against the separation of reason, sensuality, feeling, will (– preached in the most horrible scholasticism by Kant, the antipodes of Goethe); he disciplined himself to a whole, he created himself.... Goethe was, in an epoch disposed to the unreal, a convinced realist: he affirmed everything which was related to him in this respect – he had no greater experience than that ens realissimum called Napoleon. Goethe conceived of a strong, highly cultured human being, skilled in all physical accomplishments, who, keeping himself in check and having reverence for himself, dares to allow himself the whole compass and wealth of naturalness, who is strong enough for this freedom; a man of tolerance, not out of weakness, but out of strength, because he knows how to employ to his advantage what would destroy an average nature; a man to whom nothing is forbidden, except it be weakness, whether that weakness be called vice or virtue.... A spirit thus emancipated stands in the midst of the universe with a joyful and trusting fatalism, in the faith that only what is separate and individual may be rejected, that in the totality everything is redeemed and affirmed – he no longer denies.... But such a faith is the highest of all possible faiths: I have baptized it with the name Dionysos. – 50 One could say that in a certain sense the nineteenth century has also striven for what Goethe as a person strove for: universality in the understanding and affirmation, amenability to experience of whatever kind, reckless realism, reverence for everything factual. How does it happen that the total result is not a Goethe but a chaos, a nihilistic sigh, a not knowing which

way to turn, an instinct of weariness which in praxi continually tries to reach back to the eighteenth century? (– for example as romanticism of feeling, as altruism and hyper-sentimentality, as feminism in taste, as Socialism in politics). Is the nineteenth century, especially in its closing decades, not merely a strengthened, brutalized eighteenth century, that is to say a century of *décadence*? So that Goethe would have been, not merely for Germany but for all Europe, merely an episode, a beautiful ‘in vain’? – But one misunderstands great human beings if one views them from the paltry perspective of public utility. That one does not know how to make any use of it perhaps even pertains to greatness... 51 Goethe is the last German before whom I feel reverence: he would have felt three things which I feel – we are also in agreement over the ‘Cross’.* I am often asked why it is I write in German: nowhere am I worse read than in the Fatherland. But who knows, after all, whether I even wish to be read today? – To create things upon which time tries its teeth in vain; in form and in substance to strive after a little immortality – I have never been modest enough to demand less of myself. The aphorism, the apophthegm, in which I am the first master among Germans, are the forms of ‘eternity’; my ambition is to say in ten sentences what everyone else says in a book – what everyone else does not say in a book.... I have given mankind the profoundest book it possesses, my Zarathustra: I shall shortly give it the most independent.† – What I Owe to the Ancients 1 In conclusion, a word on that world into which I have sought to find a way, into which I have perhaps found a new way – the ancient world. My taste, which may be called the opposite of a tolerant taste, is even here far from uttering a wholesale Yes: in general it dislikes saying Yes, it would rather say No, most of all it prefers to say nothing at all.... This applies to entire cultures, it applies to books – it also applies to towns and countrysides. It is really only quite a small number of books of antiquity which count for anything in my life; the most famous are not among them. My sense of style, of the epigram as style, was awoken almost instantaneously on coming into contact with Sallust. I have not forgotten the astonishment of my honoured teacher Corssen when he had to give top marks to his worst Latin scholar – I had done all in a single blow. Compact, severe, with as much substance as possible, a cold malice towards ‘fine words’, also towards ‘fine feelings’ – in that I knew myself. One will recognize in my writings, even in my Zarathustra, a very serious ambition for Roman style, for the ‘aera perennius’* in style. – I had the same experience on first coming into contact with Horace. From that day to this no poet has given me the same artistic delight as I derived from the very first from an Horatian ode. In certain languages what is achieved here is not even desirable. This mosaic of words in which every word, as sound, as locus, as concept, pours forth its power to left and right and over the whole, this minimum in the range and number of signs which achieves a maximum of energy of these signs – all this is Roman and, if one will believe

me, noble par excellence. All other poetry becomes by comparison somewhat too popular – a mere emotional garrulousness... 2 I received absolutely no such strong impressions from the Greeks; and, not to mince words, they cannot be to us what the Romans are. One does not learn from the Greeks – their manner is too strange, it is also too fluid to produce an imperative, a ‘classical’ effect. Who would ever have learned to write from a Greek! Who would ever have learned it without the Romans!... Let no one offer me Plato as an objection. In respect to Plato I am a thorough sceptic and have always been unable to join in the admiration of Plato the artist which is traditional among scholars. After all, I have here the most refined judges of taste of antiquity themselves on my side. It seems to me that Plato mixes together all forms of style; he is therewith in the matter of style a first *décadent*: he has on his conscience something similar to the Cynics who devised the *Satura Menippea*.* For the Platonic dialogue, that frightfully self-satisfied and childish kind of dialectics, to operate as a stimulus one must never have read any good French writers – Fontenelle, for example. Plato is boring. – Ultimately my mistrust of Plato extends to the very bottom of him: I find him deviated so far from all the fundamental instincts of the Hellenes, so morally infected, so much an antecedent Christian – he already has the concept ‘good’ as the supreme concept – that I should prefer to describe the entire phenomenon ‘Plato’ by the harsh term ‘higher swindle’ or, if you prefer, ‘idealism’, than by any other. It has cost us dear that this Athenian went to school with the Egyptians (– or with the Jews in Egypt?...). In the great fatality of Christianity, Plato is that ambiguity and fascination called the ‘ideal’ which made it possible for the nobler natures of antiquity to misunderstand themselves and to step on to the bridge which led to the ‘Cross’.... And how much there still is of Plato in the concept ‘Church’, in the structure, system, practice of the Church! – My recreation, my preference, my cure from all Platonism has always been Thucydides. Thucydides, and perhaps the Principe of Machiavelli, are related to me closely by their unconditional will not to deceive themselves and not to see reason in reality – not in ‘reason’, still less in ‘morality’.... For the deplorable embellishment of the Greeks with the colours of the ideal which the ‘classically educated’ youth carries away with him into life as the reward of his grammar-school drilling there is no more radical cure than Thucydides. One must turn him over line by line and read his hidden thoughts as clearly as his words: there are few thinkers so rich in hidden thoughts. Sophist culture, by which I mean realist culture, attains in him its perfect expression – this invaluable movement in the midst of the morality-and-ideal swindle of the Socratic schools which was then breaking out everywhere. Greek philosophy as the *décadence* of the Greek instinct; Thucydides as the grand summation, the last manifestation of that strong, stern, hard matter-of-factness instinctive to the older Hellenes. Courage in face of reality ultimately distinguishes such natures as Thucydides and Plato:

Plato is a coward in face of reality – consequently he flees into the ideal; Thucydides has himself under control – consequently he retains control over things... 3 From scenting out ‘beautiful souls’,* ‘golden means’ and other perfections in the Greeks, from admiring in them such things as their repose in grandeur, their ideal disposition, their sublime simplicity – from this ‘sublime simplicity’, a *niaiserie allemande*† when all is said and done, I was preserved by the psychologist in me. I saw their strongest instinct, the will to power, I saw them trembling at the intractable force of this drive – I saw all their institutions evolve out of protective measures designed for mutual security against the explosive material within them. The tremendous internal tension then discharged itself in fearful and ruthless external hostility: the city states tore one another to pieces so that the citizens of each of them might find peace within himself. One needed to be strong: danger was close at hand – it lurked everywhere. The splendid supple physique, the reckless realism and immoralism which pertains to the Hellene was a necessity, not a ‘natural quality’. It was produced, it was not there from the beginning. And one employed festivals and arts for no other purpose than to feel oneself dominant, to show oneself dominant: they are means for making oneself feared.... To judge the Greeks by their philosophers, in the German manner, perchance to employ the philistinism of the Socratic schools as a clue to what is fundamentally Hellenic!... But the philosophers are the *décadents* of Hellenism, the counter-movement against the old, the noble taste (– against the agonal instinct, against the polis, against the value of the race, against the authority of tradition). The Socratic virtues were preached because the Greeks had lost them: excitable, timid, fickle, comedians every one, they had more than enough reason to let morality be preached to them. Not that it would have done any good: but big words and fine attitudes are so suited to *décadents*... 4 I was the first to take seriously that wonderful phenomenon which bears the name Dionysos as a means to understanding the older Hellenic instinct, an instinct still exuberant and even overflowing: it is explicable only as an excess of energy. Whoever has investigated the Greeks, such as that profoundest student of their culture now living, Jacob Burckhardt of Basel, realizes at once the value of this line of approach: Burckhardt inserted a special section on the said phenomenon into his *Culture of the Greeks*. For the opposite of this, one should take a look at the almost laughable poverty of instinct displayed by German philologists whenever they approach the Dionysian. The celebrated Lobeck especially, who crept into this world of mysterious states with the honest self-confidence of a dried-up bookworm and by being nauseously frivolous and childish persuaded himself he was being scientific – Lobeck intimated, with a great display of erudition, that these curiosities were of no consequence. To be sure, the priests might have communicated a number of valuable pieces of information to the participants in such orgies – that wine arouses desire, for

example, that man can live on fruit if need be, that plants bloom in spring and wither in autumn. As regards that strange wealth of rites, symbols and myths of orgiastic origin with which the antique world was quite literally overrun, Lobeck finds in them an occasion for becoming a trifle more ingenious. 'When the Greeks had nothing else to do,' he says (*Aglao-phamus* I, 672), 'they used to laugh, jump, race about, or, since man sometimes feels a desire for this, they used to sit down and weep and wail. Others later came along and sought some reason for this striking behaviour; and thus those countless myths and legends arose to explain these practices. On the other hand, one believed that the droll activities which now took place on festival days necessarily pertained to festival celebration and retained them as an indispensable part of divine worship.' – This is contemptible chatter and no one is likely to take a Lobeck seriously for a moment. We are affected quite differently when we probe the concept 'Greek' which Winckelmann and Goethe constructed for themselves and find it incompatible with that element out of which Dionysian art evolved – the orgy. I have, in fact, no doubt that Goethe would have utterly excluded anything of this kind from the possibilities of the Greek soul. Consequently Goethe did not understand the Greeks. For it is only in the Dionysian mysteries, in the psychology of the Dionysian condition, that the fundamental fact of the Hellenic instinct expresses itself – its 'will to life'. What did the Hellene guarantee to himself with these mysteries? Eternal life, the eternal recurrence of life; the future promised and consecrated in the past; the triumphant Yes to life beyond death and change; true life as collective continuation of life through procreation, through the mysteries of sexuality. It was for this reason that the sexual symbol was to the Greeks the symbol venerable as such, the intrinsic profound meaning of all antique piety. Every individual detail in the act of procreation, pregnancy, birth, awoke the most exalted and solemn feelings. In the teachings of the mysteries, pain is sanctified: the 'pains of childbirth' sanctify pain in general – all becoming and growing, all that guarantees the future, postulates pain.... For the eternal joy in creating to exist, for the will to life eternally to affirm itself, the 'torment of childbirth' must also exist eternally.... All this is contained in the word *Dionysos*: I know of no more exalted symbolism than this Greek symbolism, the symbolism of the Dionysian. The profoundest instinct of life, the instinct for the future of life, for the eternity of life, is in this word experienced religiously – the actual road to life, procreation, as the sacred road.... It was only Christianity, with resentment against life in its foundations, which made of sexuality something impure: it threw filth on the beginning, on the prerequisite of our life... 5 The psychology of the orgy as an overflowing feeling of life and energy within which even pain acts as a stimulus provided me with the key to the concept of the tragic feeling, which was misunderstood as much by Aristotle as it especially was by our pessimists. Tragedy is so far from providing evidence for

pessimism among the Hellenes in Schopenhauer's sense that it has to be considered the decisive repudiation of that idea and the counter-verdict to it. Affirmation of life even in its strangest and sternest problems, the will to life rejoicing in its own inexhaustibility through the sacrifice of its highest types – that is what I called Dionysian, that is what I recognized as the bridge to the psychology of the tragic poet. Not so as to get rid of pity and terror, not so as to purify oneself of a dangerous emotion through its vehement discharge – it was thus Aristotle understood it – : but, beyond pity and terror, to realize in oneself the eternal joy of becoming – that joy which also encompasses joy in destruction.... And with that I again return to the place from which I set out – Birth of Tragedy was my first revaluation of all values: with that I again plant myself in the soil out of which I draw all that I will and can – I, the last disciple of the philosopher Dionysos – I, the teacher of the eternal recurrence...*

The Hammer Speaks 'Why so hard?' the charcoal once said to the diamond; 'for are we not close relations?' Why so soft? O my brothers, thus I ask you: for are you not – my brothers? Why so soft, unresisting and yielding? Why is there so much denial and abnegation in your hearts? So little fate in your glances? And if you will not be fates, if you will not be inexorable: how can you – conquer with me? And if your hardness will not flash and cut and cut to pieces: how can you one day – create with me? For all creators are hard. And it must seem bliss to you to press your hand upon millennia as upon wax, bliss to write upon the will of millennia as upon metal – harder than metal, nobler than metal. Only the noblest is perfectly hard. This new law-table do I put over you, O my brothers: Become hard!*

THE ANTI-CHRIST Foreword This book belongs to the very few. Perhaps none of them is even living yet. Possibly they are the readers who understand my Zarathustra: how could I confound myself with those for whom there are ears listening today? – Only the day after tomorrow belongs to me. Some are born posthumously. The conditions under which one understands me and then necessarily understands – I know them all too well. One must be honest in intellectual matters to the point of harshness to so much as endure my seriousness, my passion. One must be accustomed to living on mountains – to seeing the wretched ephemeral chatter of politics and national egoism beneath one. One must have become indifferent, one must never ask whether truth is useful or a fatality.... Strength which prefers questions for which no one today is sufficiently daring; courage for the forbidden; predestination for the labyrinth. An experience out of seven solitudes. New ears for new music. New eyes for the most distant things. A new conscience for truths which have hitherto remained dumb. And the will to economy in the grand style: to keeping one's energy, one's enthusiasm in bounds.... Reverence for oneself; love for oneself; unconditional freedom with respect to oneself... Very well! These alone are my readers, my rightful readers, my predestined readers: what do the rest matter? – The rest are

merely mankind. – One must be superior to mankind in force, in loftiness of soul – in contempt... FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE 1 – Let us look one another in the face. We are Hyperboreans* – we know well enough how much out of the way we live. ‘Neither by land nor by sea shalt thou find the road to the Hyperboreans’: Pindar already knew that of us. Beyond the North, beyond the ice, beyond death – our life, our happiness.... We have discovered happiness, we know the road, we have found the exit out of whole millennia of labyrinth. Who else has found it? – Modern man perhaps? – ‘I know not which way to turn; I am everything that knows not which way to turn’ – sighs modern man.... It was from this modernity that we were ill – from lazy peace, from cowardly compromise, from the whole virtuous uncleanliness of modern Yes and No. This tolerance and largeness of heart which ‘forgives’ everything because it ‘Understands’ everything is sirocco to us. Better to live among ice than among modern virtues and other south winds!... We were brave enough, we spared neither ourselves nor others: but for long we did not know where to apply our courage. We became gloomy, we were called fatalists. Our fatality – was the plenitude, the tension, the blocking-up of our forces. We thirsted for lightning and action, of all things we kept ourselves furthest from the happiness of the weaklings, from ‘resignation’ There was a thunderstorm in our air, the nature which we are grew dark – for we had no road. Formula of our happiness: a Yes, a No, a straight line, a goal... 2 What is good? – All that heightens the feeling of power, the will to power, power itself in man. What is bad? – All that proceeds from weakness. What is happiness? – The feeling that power increases – that a resistance is overcome. Not contentment, but more power; not peace at all, but war; not virtue, but proficiency (virtue in the Renaissance style, virtù, virtue free of moral acid). The weak and ill-constituted shall perish: first principle of our philanthropy. And one shall help them to do so. What is more harmful than any vice? – Active sympathy for the ill-constituted and weak – Christianity... 3 The problem I raise here is not what ought to succeed mankind in the sequence of species (– the human being is a conclusion –): but what type of human being one ought to breed, ought to will, as more valuable, more worthy of life, more certain of the future. This more valuable type has existed often enough already: but as a lucky accident, as an exception, never as willed. He has rather been the most feared, he has hitherto been virtually the thing to be feared – and out of fear the reverse type has been willed, bred, achieved: the domestic animal, the herd animal, the sick animal man – the Christian... 4 Mankind does not represent a development of the better or the stronger or the higher in the way that is believed today. ‘Progress’ is merely a modern idea, that is to say a false idea. The European of today is of far less value than the European of the Renaissance; onward development is not by any means, by any necessity the same thing as elevation, advance, strengthening. In another sense there are cases of individual

success constantly appearing in the most various parts of the earth and from the most various cultures in which a higher type does manifest itself: something which in relation to collective mankind is a sort of superman. Such chance occurrences of great success have always been possible and perhaps always will be possible. And even entire races, tribes, nations can under certain circumstances represent such a lucky hit. 5 One should not embellish or dress up Christianity: it has waged a war to the death against this higher type of man, it has excommunicated all the fundamental instincts of this type, it has distilled evil, the Evil One, out of these instincts – the strong human being as the type of reprehensibility, as the ‘outcast’. Christianity has taken the side of everything weak, base, ill-constituted, it has made an ideal out of opposition to the preservative instincts of strong life; it has depraved the reason even of the intellectually strongest natures by teaching men to feel the supreme values of intellectuality as sinful, as misleading, as temptations. The most deplorable example: the depraving of Pascal, who believed his reason had been depraved by original sin while it had only been depraved by his Christianity! – 6 It is a painful, a dreadful spectacle which has opened up before me: I have drawn back the curtain on the depravity of man. In my mouth this word is protected against at any rate one suspicion: that it contains a moral accusation of man. It is – I should like to underline the fact again – free of any moralic acid: and this to the extent that I find that depravity precisely where hitherto one most consciously aspired to ‘virtue’, to ‘divinity’. I understand depravity, as will already have been guessed, in the sense of *décadence*: my assertion is that all the values in which mankind at present summarizes its highest desideratum are *décadence* values. I call an animal, a species, an individual depraved when it loses its instincts, when it chooses, when it prefers what is harmful to it. A history of the ‘higher feelings’, of the ‘ideals of mankind’ – and it is possible I shall have to narrate it – would almost also constitute an explanation of why man is so depraved. I consider life itself instinct for growth, for continuance, for accumulation of forces, for power: where the will to power is lacking there is decline. My assertion is that this will is lacking in all the supreme values of mankind – that values of decline, nihilistic values hold sway under the holiest names. 7 Christianity is called the religion of pity. – Pity stands in antithesis to the tonic emotions which enhance the energy of the feeling of life: it has a depressive effect. One loses force when one pities. The loss of force which life has already sustained through suffering is increased and multiplied even further by pity. Suffering itself becomes contagious through pity; sometimes it can bring about a collective loss of life and life-energy which stands in an absurd relation to the quantum of its cause (– the case of the death of the Nazarene). This is the first aspect; but there is an even more important one. If one judges pity by the value of the reactions which it usually brings about, its mortally dangerous character

appears in a much clearer light. Pity on the whole thwarts the law of evolution, which is the law of selection. It preserves what is ripe for destruction; it defends life's disinherited and condemned; through the abundance of the ill-constituted of all kinds which it retains in life it gives life itself a gloomy and questionable aspect. One has ventured to call pity a virtue (– in every noble morality it counts as weakness –); one has gone further, one has made of it the virtue, the ground and origin of all virtue – only, to be sure, from the viewpoint of a nihilistic philosophy which inscribed Denial of Life on its escutcheon – a fact always to be kept in view. Schopenhauer was within his rights in this: life is denied, made more worthy of denial by pity – pity is practical nihilism. To say it again, this depressive and contagious instinct thwarts those instincts bent on preserving and enhancing the value of life: both as a multiplier of misery and as a conservator of everything miserable it is one of the chief instruments for the advancement of *décadence* – pity persuades to nothingness!... One does not say 'nothingness': one says 'the Beyond'; or 'God'; or 'true life'; or Nirvana, redemption, blessedness.... This innocent rhetoric from the domain of religio-moral idiosyncrasy at once appears much less innocent when one grasps which tendency is here draping the mantle of sublime words about itself: the tendency hostile to life. Schopenhauer was hostile to life: therefore pity became for him a virtue.... Aristotle, as is well known, saw in pity a morbid and dangerous condition which one did well to get at from time to time with a purgative: he understood tragedy as a purgative. From the instinct for life one would indeed have to seek some means of puncturing so morbid and dangerous an accumulation of pity as that represented by the case of Schopenhauer (and unfortunately also by our entire literary and artistic *décadence* from St Petersburg to Paris, from Tolstoy to Wagner), so that it might burst.... Nothing in our unhealthy modernity is more unhealthy than Christian pity. To be physician here, to be inexorable here, to wield the knife here – that pertains to us, that is our kind of philanthropy, with that are we philosophers, we Hyperboreans! – 8 It is necessary to say whom we feel to be our antithesis – the theologians and all that has theologian blood in its veins – our entire philosophy.... One must have seen the fatality from close up, better still one must have experienced it in oneself, one must have almost perished by it, no longer to find anything funny here (the free-thinking of our naturalists and physiologists is to my mind funny – they lack passion in these things, they do not suffer from them –). That poison extends much further than one thinks: I have discovered the arrogant theologian-instinct wherever anyone today feels himself to be an 'idealist' – wherever anyone assumes, by virtue of a higher origin, a right to cast strange and superior looks at actuality.... Just like the priest, the idealist has all the great concepts in his hand (– and not only in his hand!), he plays them out with a benevolent contempt against the 'understanding', the 'senses', 'honours', 'luxury', 'science', he sees

these things as beneath him, as harmful and seductive forces above which ‘the spirit’ soars in pure self-sufficiency – as though humility, chastity, poverty, in a word holiness, had not hitherto done life unutterably more harm than any sort of frightfulness or vice whatever.... Pure spirit is pure lie.... So long as the priest, that denier, calumniator and poisoner of life by profession, still counts as a higher kind of human being, there can be no answer to the question: what is truth? One has already stood truth on its head when the conscious advocate of denial and nothingness counts as the representative of ‘truth’... 9 I make war on this theologian instinct: I have found traces of it everywhere. Whoever has theologian blood in his veins has a wrong and dishonest attitude towards all things from the very first. The pathos that develops out of this is called faith: closing one’s eyes with respect to oneself for good and all so as not to suffer from the sight of incurable falsity. Out of this erroneous perspective on all things one makes a morality, a virtue, a holiness for oneself, one unites the good conscience with seeing falsely – one demands that no other kind of perspective shall be accorded any value after one has rendered one’s own sacrosanct with the names ‘God’, ‘redemption’, ‘eternity’. I have dug out the theologian instinct everywhere: it is the most widespread, peculiarly subterranean form of falsity that exists on earth. What a theologian feels to be true must be false: this provides almost a criterion of truth. It is his deepest instinct of self-preservation which forbids any part of reality whatever to be held in esteem or even spoken of. Wherever the influence of the theologian extends value judgement is stood on its head, the concepts ‘true’ and ‘false’ are necessarily reversed: that which is most harmful to life is here called ‘true’, that which enhances, intensifies, affirms, justifies it and causes it to triumph is called ‘false’.... If it happens that, by way of the ‘conscience’ of princes (or of nations –), theologians stretch out their hands after power, let us be in no doubt what at bottom is taking place every time: the will to the end, the nihilistic will wants power... 10 Among Germans one will understand immediately when I say that philosophy has been corrupted by theologian blood. The Protestant pastor is the grandfather of German philosophy, Protestantism itself is its *peccatum originale*.* Definition of Protestantism: the half-sided paralysis of Christianity – and of reason.... One has only to say the words ‘College of Tübingen’† to grasp what German philosophy is at bottom – a cunning theology.... The Swabians are the best liars in Germany, they lie innocently.... Why the rejoicing heard throughout the German academic world – three-quarters composed of the sons of pastors and teachers – at the appearance of Kant? Why the Germans’ conviction, which still finds an echo even today, that with Kant things were taking a turn for the better? The theologian instinct in the German scholar divined what was henceforth possible once again.... A secret path to the old ideal stood revealed, the concept ‘real world’, the concept of morality as the essence of the world (– these two most

vicious errors in existence!) were once more, thanks to a crafty-sly scepticism, if not demonstrable yet no longer refutable.... Reason, the right of reason does not extend so far.... One had made of reality an ‘appearance’; one had made a completely fabricated world, that of being, into reality.... Kant’s success is merely a theologian’s success: German integrity was far from firm and Kant, like Luther, like Leibniz, was one more constraint upon it... 11 A word against Kant as moralist. A virtue has to be our invention, our most personal defence and necessity: in any other sense it is merely a danger. What does not condition our life harms it: a virtue merely from a feeling of respect for the concept ‘virtue’, as Kant desired it, is harmful. ‘Virtue’, ‘duty’, ‘good in itself’, impersonal and universal – phantoms, expressions of decline, of the final exhaustion of life, of Kônigsbergian Chinadom. The profoundest laws of preservation and growth demand the reverse of this: that each one of us should devise his own virtue, his own categorical imperative. A people perishes if it mistakes its own duty for the concept of duty in general. Nothing works more profound ruin than any ‘impersonal’ duty, any sacrifice to the Moloch of abstraction. – Kant’s categorical imperative* should have been felt as mortally dangerous!... The theologian instinct alone took it under its protection! – An action compelled by the instinct of life has in the joy of performing it the proof it is a right action: and that nihilist with Christian-dogmatic bowels understands joy as an objection.... What destroys more quickly than to work, to think, to feel without inner necessity, without a deep personal choice, without joy? as an automaton of ‘duty’? It is virtually a recipe for *décadence*, even for idiocy.... Kant became an idiot. – And that was the contemporary of Goethe! This fatal spider counted as the German philosopher – still does! I take care not to say what I think of the Germans.... Did Kant not see in the French Revolution the transition from the inorganic form of the state to the organic? Did he not ask himself whether there was an event which could be explained in no other way than by a moral predisposition on the part of mankind, so that with it the ‘tendency of man to seek the good’ would be proved once and for all? Kant’s answer: ‘The Revolution is that.’ The erring instinct in all and everything, antinaturalness as instinct, German *décadence* as philosophy – that is Kant! – 12 I exclude a few sceptics, the decent type in the history of philosophy: but the rest are ignorant of the first requirements of intellectual integrity. These great visionaries and prodigies behave one and all like little women – they consider ‘fine feelings’ arguments, the ‘heaving bosom’ the bellows of divinity, conviction the criterion of truth. Finally Kant, in his ‘German’ innocence, tried to give this form of corruption, this lack of intellectual conscience, a scientific colouring with the concept ‘practical reason’: he designed a reason specifically for the case in which one was supposed not to have to bother about reason, namely when morality, when the sublime demand ‘thou shalt’ makes itself heard. If one considers that

the philosopher is, in virtually all nations, only the further development of the priestly type, one is no longer surprised to discover this heirloom of the priest, self-deceptive fraudulence. If one has sacred tasks, for example that of improving, saving, redeeming mankind – if one carries the divinity in one's bosom, is the mouthpiece of an other-world imperative, such a mission already places one outside all merely reasonable valuations – one is already sanctified by such a task, one is already the type of a higher order!... What does a priest care about science! He is above it! – And the priest has hitherto ruled! – He has determined the concept 'true' and 'untrue'!... 13 Let us not undervalue this: we ourselves, we free spirits, are already a 'revaluation of all values', an incarnate declaration of war and victory over all ancient conceptions of 'true' and 'untrue'. The most valuable insights are the last to be discovered; but the most valuable insights are methods. All the methods, all the prerequisites of our present-day scientificity have for millennia been the objects of the profoundest contempt: on their account one was excluded from associating with 'honest' men – one was considered an 'enemy of God', a despiser of truth, a man 'possessed'. As a practitioner of science one was Chandala.... We have had the whole pathos of mankind against us – its conception of what truth ought to be; every 'thou shalt' has hitherto been directed against us.... Our objectives, our practices, our quiet, cautious, mistrustful manner – all this appeared utterly unworthy and contemptible to mankind. – In the end one might reasonably ask oneself whether it was not really an aesthetic taste which blinded mankind for so long: it desired a picturesque effect from truth, it desired especially that the man of knowledge should produce a powerful impression on the senses. It was our modesty which offended their taste the longest.... Oh, how well they divined that fact, those turkey-cocks of God – 14 We have learned better. We have become more modest in every respect. We no longer trace the origin of man in the 'spirit', in the 'divinity', we have placed him back among the animals. We consider him the strongest animal because he is the most cunning: his spirituality is a consequence of this. On the other hand, we guard ourselves against a vanity which would like to find expression even here: the vanity that man is the great secret objective of animal evolution. Man is absolutely not the crown of creation: every creature stands beside him at the same stage of perfection. ... And even in asserting that we assert too much: man is, relatively speaking, the most unsuccessful animal, the sickliest, the one most dangerously strayed from its instincts – with all that, to be sure, the most interesting! – As regards the animals, Descartes was the first who, with a boldness worthy of reverence, ventured to think of the animal as a machine: our whole science of physiology is devoted to proving this proposition. Nor, logically, do we exclude man, as even Descartes did: our knowledge of man today is real knowledge precisely to the extent that it is knowledge of him as a machine. Formerly man was presented with 'free will' as a dowry from a higher

order: today we have taken even will away from him, in the sense that will may no longer be understood as a faculty. The old word 'will' only serves to designate a resultant, a kind of individual reaction which necessarily follows a host of partly contradictory, partly congruous stimuli – the will no longer 'effects' anything, no longer 'moves' anything.... Formerly one saw in man's consciousness, in his 'spirit', the proof of his higher origin, his divinity; to make himself perfect man was advised to draw his senses back into himself in the manner of the tortoise, to cease to have any traffic with the earthly, to lay aside his mortal frame: then the chief part of him would remain behind, 'pure spirit'. We have thought better of this too: becoming-conscious, 'spirit', is to us precisely a symptom of a relative imperfection of the organism, as an attempting, fumbling, blundering, as a toiling in which an unnecessarily large amount of nervous energy is expended – we deny that anything can be made perfect so long as it is still made conscious. 'Pure spirit' is pure stupidity: if we deduct the nervous system and the senses, the 'mortal frame', we miscalculate – that's all!... 15 In Christianity neither morality nor religion come into contact with reality at any point. Nothing but imaginary causes ('God', 'soul', 'ego', 'spirit', 'free will' – or 'unfree will'): nothing but imaginary effects ('sin', 'redemption', 'grace', 'punishment', 'forgiveness of sins'). A traffic between imaginary beings ('God', 'spirits', 'souls'); an imaginary natural science (anthropocentric; complete lack of the concept of natural causes); an imaginary psychology (nothing but selfmisunderstandings, interpretations of pleasant or unpleasant general feelings, for example the condition of the nervus sympathicus, with the aid of the sign-language of religio-moral idiosyncrasy – 'repentance', 'sting of conscience', 'temptation by the Devil', 'the proximity of God'); an imaginary teleology ('the kingdom of God', 'the Last Judgement', 'eternal life'). – This purely fictitious world is distinguished from the world of dreams, very much to its disadvantage, by the fact that the latter mirrors actuality, while the former falsifies, disvalues and denies actuality. Once the concept 'nature' had been devised as the concept antithetical to 'God', 'natural' had to be the word for 'reprehensible' – this entire fictional world has its roots in hatred of the natural (– actuality! –), it is the expression of a profound discontent with the actual.... But that explains everything. Who alone has reason to lie himself out of actuality? He who suffers from it. But to suffer from actuality means to be an abortive actuality.... The preponderance of feelings of displeasure over feelings of pleasure is the cause of a fictitious morality and religion: such a preponderance, however, provides the formula for *décadence*... 16 A critical examination of the Christian concept of God invites a similar conclusion. – A people which still believes in itself still also has its own God. In him it venerates the conditions through which it has prospered, its virtues – it projects its joy in itself, its feeling of power on to a being whom one can thank for them. He who is rich wants to

bestow; a proud people needs a God in order to sacrifice.... With in the bounds of such presuppositions religion is a form of gratitude. One is grateful for oneself: for that one needs a God. – Such a God must be able to be both useful and harmful, both friend and foe – he is admired in good and bad alike. The anti-natural castration of a God into a God of the merely good would be totally undesirable here. One has as much need of the evil God as of the good God: for one does not owe one's existence to philanthropy or tolerance precisely.... Of what consequence would a God be who knew nothing of anger, revengefulness, envy, mockery, cunning, acts of violence? To whom even the rapturous ardeurs of victory and destruction were unknown? One would not understand such a God: why should one have him? – To be sure: when a people is perishing; when it feels its faith in the future, its hope of freedom vanish completely; when it becomes conscious that the most profitable thing of all is submissiveness and that the virtues of submissiveness are a condition of its survival, then its God has to alter too. He now becomes a dissembler, timid, modest, counsels 'peace of soul', no more hatred, forbearance, 'love' even towards friend and foe. He is continually moralizing, he creeps into the cave of every private virtue, becomes a God for everybody, becomes a private man, becomes a cosmopolitan.... Formerly he represented a people, the strength of a people, everything aggressive and thirsting for power in the soul of a people: now he is merely the good God.... There is in fact no other alternative for Gods: either they are the will to power – and so long as they are that they will be national Gods – or else the impotence for power – and then they necessarily become good... 17 Wherever the will to power declines in any form there is every time also a physiological regression, a *décadence*. The divinity of *décadence*, pruned of all its manliest drives and virtues, from now on necessarily becomes the God of the physiologically retarded, the weak. They do not call themselves the weak, they call themselves 'the good'.... One will understand without further indication at what moment of history the dual fiction of a good and an evil God first becomes possible. The same instinct which makes the subjugated people reduce its God to the 'good in itself makes them expunge the good qualities from the God of their conqueror; they revenge themselves on their masters by changing their masters' God into a devil. – The good God and the Devil: both products of *décadence*. – How can one today still defer so far to the simplicity of Christian theologians as to join them in proclaiming that the evolution of the concept of God from the 'God of Israel', the national God, to the Christian God, the epitome of everything good, is an advance? – But even Renan does so. As if Renan had a right to simplicity! For it is the opposite which leaps to the eye. When the prerequisites of ascending life, when everything strong, brave, masterful, proud is eliminated from the concept of God; when he declines step by step to the symbol of a staff for the weary, a sheet-anchor for all who are drowning; when he becomes the

poor people's God, the sinner's God, the God of the sick par excellence, and the predicate 'saviour', 'redeemer' as it were remains over as the predicate of divinity as such: of what does such a transformation speak? such a reduction of the divine? – To be sure: 'the kingdom of God' has thereby grown larger. Formerly he had only his people, his 'chosen' people. In the meantime, just like his people itself, he has gone abroad, gone wandering about; since then he has sat still nowhere: until at last he is at home everywhere, the great cosmopolitan – until he has got 'the great majority' and half the earth on his side. But the God of the 'great majority', the democrat among Gods, has none the less not become a proud pagan God: he has remained a Jew, he has remained the God of the nook, the God of all the dark corners and places, of all unhealthy quarters throughout the world!... His world-empire is as before an underworld-empire, a hospital, a souterrain-empire, a ghetto-empire.... And he himself so pale, so weak, so décadent.... Even the palest of the pale have still been able to master him, messieurs the metaphysicians, the conceptual albinos. These have spun their web around him so long that, hypnotized by their movements, he himself became a spider, a metaphysician. Thence forward he span the world again out of himself – sub specie Spinozæ – thenceforward he transformed himself into something ever paler and less substantial, became an 'ideal', became 'pure spirit', became 'absolutum', became 'thing in itself.... Decay of a God: God became 'thing in itself'... 18 The Christian conception of God – God as God of the sick, God as spider, God as spirit – is one of the most corrupt conceptions of God arrived at on earth: perhaps it even represents the low-water mark in the descending development of the God type. God degenerated to the contradiction of life, instead of being its transfiguration and eternal Yes! In God a declaration of hostility towards life, nature, the will to life! God the formula for every calumny of 'this world', for every lie about 'the next world'! In God nothingness deified, the will to nothingness sanctified!... 19 That the strong races of northern Europe have not repudiated the Christian God certainly reflects no credit on their talent for religion – not to speak of their taste. They ought to have felt compelled to have done with such a sickly and decrepit product of décadence. But there lies a curse on them for not having had done with it: they have taken up sickness, old age, contradiction into all their instincts – since then they have failed to create a God! Almost two millennia and not a single new God! But still, and as if existing by right, like an ultimate and maximum of the God-creating force, of the creator spiritus in man, this pitiable God of Christian monotono-theism! This hybrid of the void, conceptualism and contradiction, this picture of decay, in which all décadence instincts, all cowardliness and weariness of soul have their sanction! – 20 With my condemnation of Christianity, I should not like to have wronged a kindred religion which even preponderates in the number of its believers: Buddhism. They belong together as nihilistic religions – they are décadence

religions – but they are distinguished from one another in the most remarkable way. The critic of Christianity is profoundly grateful to Indian scholars that one is now able to compare these two religions. – Buddhism is a hundred times more realistic than Christianity – it has the heritage of a cool and objective posing of problems in its composition, it arrives after a philosophical movement lasting hundreds of years; the concept ‘God’ is already abolished by the time it arrives. Buddhism is the only really positivistic religion history has to show us, even in its epistemology (a strict phenomenalism –), it no longer speaks of ‘the struggle against sin’ but, quite in accordance with actuality, ‘the struggle against suffering’. It already has – and this distinguishes it profoundly from Christianity – the self-deception of moral concepts behind it – it stands, in my language, beyond good and evil. – The two physiological facts upon which it rests and on which it fixes its eyes are: firstly an excessive excitability of sensibility which expresses itself as a refined capacity for pain, then an over-intellectuality, a too great preoccupation with concepts and logical procedures under which the personal instinct has sustained harm to the advantage of the ‘impersonal’ (– both of them conditions which at any rate some of my readers, the objective ones, will know from experience, as I do). On the basis of these physiological conditions a state of depression has arisen: against this depression Buddha takes hygienic measures. He opposes it with life in the open air, the wandering life; with moderation and fastidiousness as regards food; with caution towards all emotions which produce gall, which heat the blood; no anxiety, either for oneself or for others. He demands ideas which produce repose or cheerfulness – he devises means for disaccustoming oneself to others. He understands benevolence, being kind, as health-promoting. Prayer is excluded, as is asceticism; no categorical imperative, no compulsion at all, not even with in the monastic community (– one can leave it –). All these would have the effect of increasing that excessive excitability. For this reason too he demands no struggle against those who think differently; his teaching resists nothing more than it resists the feeling of revengefulness, of antipathy, of resentment (– ‘enmity is not ended by enmity’: the moving refrain of the whole of Buddhism...). And quite rightly: it is precisely these emotions which would be thoroughly unhealthy with regard to the main dietetic objective. The spiritual weariness he discovered and which expressed itself as an excessive ‘objectivity’ (that is to say weakening of individual interest, loss of centre of gravity, of ‘egoism’), he combated by directing even the spiritual interests back to the individual person. In the teaching of Buddha egoism becomes a duty: the ‘one thing needful’, the ‘how can you get rid of suffering’ regulates and circumscribes the entire spiritual diet (– one may perhaps call to mind that Athenian who likewise made war on pure ‘scientificality’, Socrates, who elevated personal egoism to morality even in the domain of problems). 21 The precondition for Buddhism is a very mild climate,

very gentle and liberal customs, no militarism; and that it is the higher and even learned classes in which the movement has its home. The supreme goal is cheerfulness, stillness, absence of desire, and this goal is achieved. Buddhism is not a religion in which one merely aspires after perfection: perfection is the normal case. – In Christianity the instincts of the subjugated and oppressed come into the foreground: it is the lowest classes which seek their salvation in it. Here the casuistic business of sin, self-criticism, conscience-inquisition is practised as a specific against boredom; here an emotional attitude towards a power, called ‘God’, is kept constantly alive (through prayer); here the highest things are considered unachievable, gifts, ‘grace’. Here public openness is also lacking; the hole-and-corner, the dark chamber is Christian. Here the body is despised, hygiene repudiated as sensuality; the Church even resists cleanliness (– the first measure taken by the Christians after the expulsion of the Moors was the closure of the public baths, of which Cordova alone possessed 270). A certain sense of cruelty towards oneself and others is Christian; hatred of those who think differently; the will to persecute. Gloomy and exciting ideas stand in the foreground; the states most highly desired and designated by the highest names are epileptoid states; diet is selected so as to encourage morbid phenomena and to over-excite the nerves. Mortal hostility against the masters of the earth, against the ‘noble’ – and at the same time a covert secret competition (– one allows them the ‘body’, one wants only the ‘soul’): that is also Christian. Hatred of mind, of pride, courage, freedom, libertinage of mind is Christian; hatred of the senses, of the joy of the senses, of joy in general is Christian... 22 When it left its original home, the lowest orders, the underworld of the ancient world, when it went in search of power among barbarian peoples, Christianity had no longer to presuppose weary human beings but inwardly savage and self-lacerating ones – strong but ill-constituted human beings. Here discontentedness with oneself, suffering from oneself is not, as it is with the Buddhists, an immoderate excitability and capacity for pain, but on the contrary an overwhelming desire to do harm, to discharge an inner tension in hostile actions and ideas. To dominate barbarians Christianity had need of barbarous concepts and values: sacrifice of the first-born, blood-drinking at communion, contempt for intellect and culture; torture in all its forms, physical and non-physical; great pomp brought to public worship. Buddhism is a religion for late human beings, for races grown kindly, gentle, over-intellectual who feel pain too easily (– Europe is not nearly ripe for it –): it leads them back to peace and cheerfulness, to an ordered diet in intellectual things, to a certain physical hardening. Christianity desires to dominate beasts of prey; its means for doing so is to make them sick – weakening is the Christian recipe for taming, for ‘civilization’. Buddhism is a religion for the end and fatigue of a civilization, Christianity does not even find civilization in existence – it establishes civilization if need be. 23 Buddhism, to

say it again, is a hundred times colder, more veracious, more objective. It no longer needs to make its suffering and capacity for pain decent to itself by interpreting it as sin – it merely says what it feels: ‘I suffer’. To the barbarian, on the contrary, suffering in itself is not decent: he first requires it to be interpreted before he will admit to himself that he suffers (his instinct directs him rather to deny he is suffering, to a silent endurance). Here the word ‘Devil’ was a blessing: one had an overwhelming and fearful enemy – one did not need to be ashamed of suffering at the hands of such an enemy. – Christianity has a number of subtleties in its foundations which belong to the Orient. Above all, it knows that it is in itself a matter of absolute indifference whether a thing be true, but a matter of the highest importance to what extent it is believed to be true. Truth and the belief that something is true: two completely diverse worlds of interest, almost antithetical worlds – one gets to them by fundamentally different roads. To be knowledgeable in this – in the Orient that is almost enough to constitute a sage: thus the Brahmins* understood it, thus Plato understands it, thus does every student of esoteric wisdom understand it. If, for example, there is happiness to be found in believing oneself redeemed from sin, it is not necessary for a man first to be sinful, but for him to feel himself sinful. If, however, it is belief as such which is necessary above all else, then one has to bring reason, knowledge, inquiry into disrepute: the road to truth becomes the forbidden road. – Intense hope is a much stronger stimulant to life than any single instance of happiness which actually occurs. Sufferers have to be sustained by a hope which cannot be refuted by any actuality – which is not done away with by any fulfilment: a hope in the Beyond. (It was precisely on account of this capacity for keeping the unhappy in suspense that the Greeks considered hope the evil of evils, the actual malignant evil: it remained behind in the box of evil.) – So that love shall be possible, God has to be a person; so that the lowest instincts shall have a voice, God has to be young. To satisfy the ardour of the women a handsome saint is moved into the foreground, to satisfy that of the men a Mary. This on the presupposition that Christianity desires to become master on a soil where the worship of Adonis or Aphrodite has already determined the concept of what religious worship is. The requirement of chastity increases the vehemence and inward intensity of the religious instinct – it renders the cult warmer, more enthusiastic, more soulful. – Love is the state in which man sees things most of all as they are not. The illusioncreating force is there at its height, likewise the sweetening and transforming force. One endures more when in love than one otherwise would, one tolerates everything. The point was to devise a religion in which love is possible: with that one is beyond the worst that life can offer – one no longer even sees it. – So much for the three Christian virtues faith, hope and charity:† I call them the three Christian shrewdnesses. – Buddhism is too late, too positivistic still to be shrewd in this fashion. – 24 I only touch on the problem

of the origin of Christianity here. The first proposition towards its solution is: Christianity can be understood only by referring to the soil out of which it grew – it is not a counter-movement against the Jewish instinct, it is actually its logical consequence, one further conclusion of its fear-inspiring logic. In the Redeemer's formula: 'Salvation is of the Jews'. – The second proposition is: the psychological type of the Galilean is still recognizable – but only in a completely degenerate form (which is at once a mutilation and an overloading with foreign traits) could it serve the end to which it was put, that of being the type of a redeemer of mankind. – The Jews are the most remarkable nation of world history because, faced with the question of being or not being, they preferred, with a perfectly uncanny conviction, being at any price: the price they had to pay was the radical falsification of all nature, all naturalness, all reality, the entire inner world as well as the outer. They defined themselves counter to all those conditions under which a nation was previously able to live, was permitted to live; they made of themselves an antithesis to natural conditions – they inverted religion, religious worship, morality, history, psychology one after the other in an irreparable way into the contradiction of their natural values. We encounter the same phenomenon again and in unutterably vaster proportions, although only as a copy – the Christian Church, in contrast to the 'nation of saints', renounces all claim to originality. For precisely this reason the Jews are the most fateful nation in world history; their after-effect has falsified mankind to such an extent that today the Christian is able to feel anti-Jewish without realizing he is the ultimate consequence of the Jews. In my *Genealogy of Morals* I introduced for the first time the psychology of the antithetical concepts of a noble morality and a resentment morality, the latter deriving from a denial of the former: but this latter corresponds totally to JudeoChristian morality. To be able to reject all that represents the ascending movement of life, well-constitutedness, power, beauty, self-affirmation on earth, the instinct of resentment here become genius had to invent another world from which that lifeaffirmation would appear evil, reprehensible as such. Considered psychologically, the Jewish nation is a nation of the toughest vital energy which, placed in impossible circumstances, voluntarily, from the profoundest shrewdness in selfpreservation, took the side of all decadence instincts – not as being dominated by them but because it divined in them a power by means of which one can prevail against 'the world'. The Jews are the counterparts of décadents: they have been compelled to act as décadents to the point of illusion, they have known, with a non plus ultra of histrionic genius, how to place themselves at the head of all decadence movements (– as the Christianity of Paul –) so as to make of them something stronger than any party affirmative of life. For the kind of man who desires to attain power through Judaism and Christianity, the priestly kind, decadence is only a means: this kind of man has a life-interest in making mankind sick and in

inverting the concepts 'good' and 'evil', 'true' and 'false' in a mortally dangerous and worldcalumniating sense. – 25 The history of Israel is invaluable as a typical history of the denaturalizing of natural values: I shall indicate five stages in the process. Originally, above all in the period of the Kingdom, Israel too stood in a correct, that is to say natural relationship to all things. Their Yaweh was the expression of their consciousness of power, of their delight in themselves, their hopes of themselves: in him they anticipated victory and salvation, with him they trusted that nature would provide what the people needed – above all rain. Yaweh is the God of Israel and consequently the God of justice: the logic of every nation that is in power and has a good conscience about it. These two aspects of a nation's self-affirmation find expression in festival worship: it is grateful for the great destiny which has raised it on high, it is grateful towards the year's seasons and all its good fortune with livestock and husbandry. – This state of things long remained the ideal, even after it had been tragically done away with: anarchy with in, the Assyrian from without. But the people retained as its supreme desideratum that vision of a king who is a good soldier and an upright judge: as did above all the typical prophet (that is to say critic and satirist of the hour) Isaiah. – But every hope remained unfulfilled. The old God could no longer do what he formerly could. One should have let him go. What happened? One altered the conception of him: at this price one retained him. Yaweh the God of 'justice' – no longer at one with Israel, an expression of national selfconfidence: now only a God bound by conditions. The new conception of him becomes an instrument in the hands of priestly agitators who henceforth interpret all good fortune as a reward, all misfortune as punishment for disobedience of God, for 'sin': that most mendacious mode of interpretation of a supposed 'moral worldorder' through which the natural concept 'cause' and 'effect' is once and for all stood on its head. When one has banished natural causality from the world by means of reward and punishment, one then requires an anti-natural causality: all the remaining unnaturalness follows forthwith. A God who demands – in place of a God who helps, who devises means, who is fundamentally a word for every happy inspiration of courage and self-reliance.... Morality no longer the expression of the conditions under which a nation lives and grows, no longer a nation's deepest instinct of life, but become abstract, become the antithesis of life – morality as a fundamental degradation of the imagination, as an 'evil eye' for all things. What is Jewish, what is Christian morality? Chance robbed of its innocence; misfortune dirtied by the concept 'sin'; well-being as a danger, as 'temptation'; physiological indisposition poisoned by the worm of conscience... 26 The concept of God falsified; the concept of morality falsified – the Jewish priesthood did not stop there. The entire history of Israel was useless: away with it! – These priests perpetrated that miracle of falsification the documentation of which lies before us in a good part of the Bible: with unparalleled disdain of

every tradition, every historical reality, they translated their own national past into religious terms, that is to say they made of it a stupid salvation-mechanism of guilt towards Yaweh and punishment, piety towards Yaweh and reward. We would feel this most shameful act of historical falsification much more painfully if millennia of ecclesiastical interpretation of history had not made us almost oblivious to the demands of integrity in historicis. And the philosophers have seconded the Church: the lie of a 'moral world-order' permeates the whole evolution even of the most recent philosophy. What does 'moral world-order' mean? That there exists once and for all a will of God as to what man is to do and what he is not to do; that the value of a nation, of an individual is to be measured by how much or how little obedience is accorded the will of God; that the ruling power of the will of God, expressed as punishment and reward according to the degree of obedience, is demonstrated in the destiny of a nation, of an individual. – The reality displaced by this pitiable lie is: a parasitic kind of human being which prospers only at the expense of every healthy form of life, the priest, abuses the name of God: he calls a state of society in which the priest determines the value of things 'the kingdom of God'; he calls the means by which such a state is achieved or perpetuated 'the will of God'; with coldblooded cynicism he assesses nations, epochs, individuals according to whether they were conducive to the rule of priests or whether they resisted it. Observe them at work: in the hands of the Jewish priests the great epoch in the history of Israel became an epoch of decay, the Exile, the long years of misfortune, was transformed into an eternal punishment for the great epoch – an epoch in which the priest was as yet nothing. According to their requirements they made the mighty, very freely constituted figures of Israel's history into either pathetic cringing bigots or 'godless men', they simplified the psychology of every great event into the idiotic formula 'obedience to or disobedience of God'. – A further step: the 'will of God' (that is to say the conditions for preserving the power of the priest) has to be known – to this end a 'revelation' is required. In plain words: a great literary forgery becomes necessary, a 'sacred book' is discovered – it is made public with all hieratic pomp, with days of repentance and with lamentation over the long years of 'sinfulness'. The 'will of God' had been established years before: the whole evil lay in the nation's having become estranged from the 'sacred book'.... The 'will of God' had been revealed already to Moses.... What had happened? The priest had, with precision and pedantry, right down to the imposts large and small which had to be paid to him (– not forgetting the tastiest pieces of meat: for the priest is a befeater), formulated once and for all what he intends to have, 'what the will of God is'.... From now on all things of life are so ordered that the priest is everywhere indispensable; at all the natural events of life, at birth, marriage, sickness, death, not to speak of 'sacrifice' (meal-times), there appears the holy parasite to denaturalize them – in his language to

‘sanctify’ them.... For one must grasp this: every natural custom, every natural institution (state, administration of justice, marriage, tending of the sick and poor), every requirement presented by the instinct for life, in short everything valuable in itself, becomes utterly valueless, inimical to value through the parasitism of the priest (or the ‘moral world-order’): a sanction is subsequently required – a value-bestowing power is needed which denies the natural quality in these things and only by doing so is able to create a value.... The priest disvalues, dissanctifies nature: it is only at the price of this that he exists at all. – Disobedience of God, that is to say of the priest, of ‘the Law’, now acquires the name ‘sin’; the means of ‘becoming reconciled again with God’ are, as is only to be expected, means by which subjection to the priest is only more thoroughly guaranteed: the priest alone ‘redeems’.... From a psychological point of view, ‘sins’ are indispensable in any society organized by priests: they are the actual levers of power, the priest lives on sins, he needs ‘the commission of sins’.... Supreme law: ‘God forgives him who repents’ – in plain language: who subjects himself to the priest. – 27 On a soil falsified in this way, where all nature, all natural value, all reality had the profoundest instincts of the ruling class against it, there arose Christianity, a form of mortal hostility to reality as yet unsurpassed. The ‘holy people’, which had retained only priestly values, priestly words, for all things, and with a consistency capable of inspiring fear had separated itself from everything else powerful on earth, calling it ‘unholy’, ‘world’, ‘sin’ – this people produced for its instinct a formula which was logical to the point of self-negation: as Christianity it negated the last remaining form of reality, the ‘holy people’, the ‘chosen people’, the Jewish reality itself. The case is of the first rank: the little rebellious movement which is baptized with the name of Jesus of Nazareth is the Jewish instinct once more – in other words the priestly instinct which can no longer endure the priest as a reality, the invention of an even more abstract form of existence, an even more unreal vision of the world than one conditioned by an organized Church. Christianity negates the Church... I fail to see against what the revolt was directed whose originator Jesus is understood or misunderstood to be if it was not a revolt against the Jewish Church – ‘Church’ taken in precisely the sense in which we take the word today. It was a revolt against ‘the good and the just’, against ‘the saints of Israel’, against the social hierarchy – not against a corruption of these but against caste, privilege, the order, the social form; it was disbelief in ‘higher men’, a No uttered towards everything that was priest and theologian. But the hierarchy which was thus called in question, even if only momentarily, was the pile-work upon which the Jewish nation continued to exist at all in the midst of the ‘waters’ – the laboriously-achieved last possibility of remaining in being, the residuum of its separate political existence: an attack on this was an attack on the profoundest national instinct, on the toughest national will to life which has ever existed on

earth. This holy anarchist who roused up the lowly, the outcasts and ‘sinners’, the Chandala within Judaism to oppose the ruling order – in language which, if the Gospels are to be trusted, would even today lead to Siberia – was a political criminal, in so far as political criminals were possible in an absurdly unpolitical society. This is what brought him to the Cross: the proof is the inscription on the Cross. He died for his guilt – all ground is lacking for the assertion, however often it is made, that he died for the guilt of others. – 28 It is quite another question whether he was conscious of any such antithesis – whether he was not merely felt to be this antithesis. And here for the first time I touch on the problem of the psychology of the redeemer. – I confess there are few books which present me with so many difficulties as the Gospels do. These difficulties are quite other than those which the learned curiosity of the German mind celebrated one of its most unforgettable triumphs in pointing out. The time is far distant when I too, like every young scholar and with the clever dullness of a refined philologist, savoured the work of the incomparable Strauss. I was then twenty years old: now I am too serious for that. What do I care for the contradictions of ‘tradition’? How can legends of saints be called ‘tradition’ at all! The stories of saints are the most ambiguous literature in existence: to apply to them scientific procedures when no other records are extant seems to me wrong in principle – mere learned idling... 29 What I am concerned with is the psychological type of the redeemer. For it could be contained in the Gospels in spite of the Gospels, however much mutilated and overloaded with foreign traits: as that of Francis of Assisi is contained in the legends about him in spite of the legends. Not the truth about what he did, what he said, how he really died: but the question whether his type is still conceivable at all, whether it has been ‘handed down’ by tradition. – The attempts I know of to extract even the history of a ‘soul’ from the Gospels seem to me proofs of an execrable psychological frivolity. Monsieur Renan, that buffoon in psychologicis, has appropriated for his explication of the type Jesus the two most inapplicable concepts possible in this case: the concept of the genius and the concept of the hero. But if anything is unevangelic it is the concept hero. Precisely the opposite of all contending, of all feeling oneself in struggle has here become instinct: the incapacity for resistance here becomes morality (‘resist not evil!’: the profoundest saying of the Gospel, its key in a certain sense), blessedness in peace, in gentleness, in the inability for enmity. What are the ‘glad tidings’? True life, eternal life is found – it is not promised, it is here, it is within you: as life lived in love, in love without deduction or exclusion, without distance. Everyone is a child of God – Jesus definitely claims nothing for himself alone – as a child of God everyone is equal to everyone else.... To make a hero of Jesus! – And what a worse misunderstanding is the word ‘genius’! Our whole concept, our cultural concept ‘spirit’ had no meaning whatever in the world Jesus lived in. To speak with the precision of the

physiologist a quite different word would rather be in place here: the word idiot. We recognize a condition of morbid susceptibility of the sense of touch which makes it shrink back in horror from every contact, every grasping of a firm object. Translate such a physiological habitus* into its ultimate logic – as instinctive hatred of every reality, as flight into the ‘ungraspable’, into the ‘inconceivable’, as antipathy towards every form, every spacial and temporal concept, towards everything firm, all that is custom, institution, Church, as being at home in a world undisturbed by reality of any kind, a merely ‘inner’ world, a ‘real’ world, an ‘eternal’ world.... ‘The kingdom of God is within you’... 30

Instinctive hatred of reality: consequence of an extreme capacity for suffering and irritation which no longer wants to be ‘touched’ at all because it feels every contact too deeply. Instinctive exclusion of all aversion, all enmity, all feeling for limitation and distancing: consequence of an extreme capacity for suffering and irritation which already feels all resisting, all need for resistance, as an unbearable displeasure (that is to say as harmful, as deprecated by the instinct of self-preservation) and knows blessedness (pleasure) only in no longer resisting anyone or anything, neither the evil nor the evil-doer – love as the sole, as the last possibility of life... These are the two physiological realities upon which, out of which the doctrine of redemption has grown. I call it a sublime further evolution of hedonism on a thoroughly morbid basis. Closest related to it, even if with a considerable addition of Greek vitality and nervous energy, is Epicureanism, the redemption doctrine of the pagan world. Epicurus a typical décadent: first recognized as such by me. – The fear of pain, even of the infinitely small in pain – cannot end otherwise than in a religion of love... 31

I have anticipated my answer to the problem. Its presupposition is that the type of the redeemer has been preserved to us only in a very distorted form. That this distortion should have occurred is in itself very probable: there are several reasons why such a type could not remain pure, whole, free of accretions. The milieu in which this strange figure moved must have left its mark upon him, as must even more the history, the fate of the first Christian community: from this the type was retrospectively enriched with traits which become comprehensible only with reference to warfare and the aims of propaganda. That strange and sick world to which the Gospels introduce us – a world like that of a Russian novel, in which refuse of society, neurosis and ‘childlike’ idiocy seem to make a rendezvous – must in any case have coarsened the type: the first disciples in particular had to translate a being immersed entirely in symbols and incomprehensibilities into their own crudity in order to understand anything of it at all – for them such a type could not exist until it had been reduced to more familiar forms.... The prophet, the Messiah, the judge who is to come, the moral preacher, the miracle-worker, John the Baptist – so many opportunities for misunderstanding the type.... Finally, let us not underestimate the proprium* of

all extreme, and in particular sectarian veneration: it extinguishes the original often painfully unfamiliar traits and idiosyncrasies in the revered being – it even fails to see them. One has to regret that no Dostoyevsky lived in the neighbourhood of this most interesting *décadent*; I mean someone who could feel the thrilling fascination of such a combination of the sublime, the sick and the childish. One final viewpoint: the type, as a *décadence* type, could in fact have been of a peculiar multiplicity and contradictoriness: such a possibility cannot be entirely excluded. But everything speaks against it: for if it were so the tradition would have to have been remarkably faithful and objective: and we have reasons for assuming the opposite. In the meantime, there yawns a contradiction between the mountain, lake and field preacher, whose appearance strikes one as that of a Buddha on a soil very little like that of India, and the aggressive fanatic, the mortal enemy of theologian and priest, which Renan has wickedly glorified as ‘*le grand maitre en ironie*’. I myself have no doubt that this plentiful measure of gall (and even of *esprit*) has only overflowed on to the type of the Master out of the excited condition of Christian propaganda: for one knows very well how resolutely all sectarians adjust their Master into an apologia of themselves. When the first community had need of a censuring theologian to oppose the theologians they created their ‘God’ according to their requirements: just as they unhesitatingly put into his mouth those totally unevangelic concepts which they could not now do without, ‘Second Coming’, ‘Last Judgement’, every kind of temporal promise and expectation. – 32 I resist, to repeat it, the incorporation of the fanatic into the type of the redeemer: the word *impérieux* alone which Renan employs already annuls the type. The ‘glad tidings’ are precisely that there are no more opposites; the kingdom of Heaven belongs to children; the faith which here finds utterance is not a faith which has been won by struggle – it is there, from the beginning, it is as it were a return to childishness in the spiritual domain. The occurrence of retarded puberty undeveloped in the organism as a consequence of degeneration is familiar at any rate to physiologists. – Such a faith is not angry, does not censure, does not defend itself: it does not bring ‘the sword’ – it has no idea to what extent it could one day cause dissention. It does not prove itself, either by miracles or by rewards and promises, and certainly not ‘by the Scriptures’: it is every moment its own miracle, its own reward, its own proof, its own ‘kingdom of God’. Neither does this faith formulate itself – it lives, it resists formulas. Chance, to be sure, determines the environment, the language, the preparatory schooling of a particular configuration of concepts: primitive Christianity employs only Judeo-Semitic concepts (– eating and drinking at communion belong here, concepts so sadly abused, like everything Jewish, by the Church). But one must be careful not to see in this anything but a sign-language, a semeiotic, an occasion for metaphors. It is precisely on condition that nothing he says is taken literally that this anti-realist can speak at all. Among

Indians he would have made use of Sankhyam concepts, among Chinese those of Lao-tse – and would not have felt the difference. – One could, with some freedom of expression, call Jesus a ‘free spirit’ – he cares nothing for what is fixed: the word killeth, everything fixed killeth. The concept, the experience ‘life’ in the only form he knows it is opposed to any kind of word, formula, law, faith, dogma. He speaks only of the inmost thing: ‘life’ or ‘truth’ or ‘light’ is his expression for the inmost thing – everything else, the whole of reality, the whole of nature, language itself, possesses for him merely the value of a sign, a metaphor. – On this point one must make absolutely no mistake, however much Christian, that is to say ecclesiastical prejudice, may tempt one to do so: such a symbolist par excellence stands outside of all religion, all conceptions of divine worship, all history, all natural science, all experience of the world, all acquirements, all politics, all psychology, all books, all art – his ‘knowledge’ is precisely the pure folly of the fact that anything of this kind exists. He has not so much as heard of culture, he does not need to fight against it – he does not deny it.... The same applies to the state, to society and the entire civic order, to work, to war – he never had reason to deny ‘the world’, he had no notion of the ecclesiastical concept ‘world’.... Denial is precisely what is totally impossible for him. – Dialectics are likewise lacking, the idea is lacking that a faith, a ‘truth’ could be proved by reasons (– his proofs are inner ‘lights’, inner feelings of pleasure and self-affirmations, nothing but ‘proofs by potency’ –). Neither can such a doctrine argue: it simply does not understand that other doctrines exist, can exist, it simply does not know how to imagine an opinion contrary to its own.... Where it encounters one it will, with the most heartfelt sympathy, lament the ‘blindness’ – for it sees the ‘light’ – but it will make no objection... 33 In the entire psychology of the ‘Gospel’ the concept guilt and punishment is lacking; likewise the concept reward. ‘Sin’, every kind of distancing relationship between God and man, is abolished – precisely this is the ‘glad tidings’. Blessedness is not promised, it is not tied to any conditions: it is the only reality – the rest is signs for speaking of it... The consequence of such a condition projects itself into a new practice, the true evangelic practice. It is not a ‘belief’ which distinguishes the Christian: the Christian acts, he is distinguished by a different mode of acting. Neither by words nor in his heart does he resist the man who does him evil. He makes no distinction between foreigner and native, between Jew and non-Jew (‘one’s neighbour’ is properly one’s co-religionist, the Jew). He is not angry with anyone, does not disdain anyone. He neither appears in courts of law nor claims their protection (‘not swearing’). Under no circumstances, not even in the case of proved unfaithfulness, does he divorce his wife. – All fundamentally one law, all consequences of one instinct. – The life of the redeemer was nothing else than this practice – his death too was nothing else.... He no longer required any formulas, any rites for communicating with God – not

even prayer. He has settled his accounts with the whole Jewish penance-and-reconciliation doctrine; he knows that it is through the practice of one's life that one feels 'divine', 'blessed', 'evangelic', at all times a 'child of God'. It is not 'penance', not 'prayer for forgiveness' which leads to God: evangelic practice alone leads to God, it is God! – What was abolished with the Evangel was the Judaism of the concepts 'sin', 'forgiveness of sin', 'faith', 'redemption by faith' – the whole of Jewish ecclesiastical teaching was denied in the 'glad tidings'. The profound instinct for how one would have to live in order to feel oneself 'in Heaven', to feel oneself 'eternal', while in every other condition one by no means feels oneself 'in Heaven': this alone is the psychological reality of 'redemption'. – A new way of living, not a new belief... 34 If I understand anything of this great symbolist it is that he took for realities, for 'truths', only inner realities – that he understood the rest, everything pertaining to nature, time, space, history, only as signs, as occasion for metaphor. The concept 'the Son of Man' is not a concrete person belonging to history, anything at all individual or unique, but an 'eternal' fact, a psychological symbol freed from the time concept. The same applies supremely to the God of this typical symbolist, to the 'kingdom of God', to the 'kingdom of Heaven', to 'God's children'. Nothing is more un-Christian than the ecclesiastical crudities of a God as a person, of a 'kingdom of God' which comes, of a 'kingdom of Heaven' in the Beyond, of a 'Son of God', the second person of the Trinity. All this – forgive the expression – a fist in the eye* – oh in what an eye! – of the Gospel: world-historical cynicism in the mockery of symbolism.... But it is patently obvious what is alluded to in the symbols 'Father' and 'Son' – not patently obvious to everyone, I grant: in the word 'Son' is expressed the entry into the collective feeling of the transfiguration of all things (blessedness), in the word 'Father' this feeling itself, the feeling of perfection and eternity. – I am ashamed to recall what the Church has made of this symbolism: has it not set an Amphytrion† story at the threshold of Christian 'faith'? And a dogma of 'immaculate conception' into the bargain?... But it has thereby maculated conception– The 'Kingdom of Heaven' is a condition of the heart – not something that comes 'upon the earth' or 'after death'. The entire concept of natural death is lacking in the Gospel: death is not a bridge, not a transition, it is lacking because it belongs to quite another world, a merely apparent world useful only for the purpose of symbolism. The 'hour of death' is not a Christian concept – the 'hour', time, physical life and its crises, simply do not exist for the teacher of the 'glad tidings'. ... The 'kingdom of God' is not something one waits for; it has no yesterday or tomorrow, it does not come 'in a thousand years' – it is an experience within a heart; it is everywhere, it is nowhere... 35 This 'bringer of glad tidings' died as he lived, as he taught – not to 'redeem mankind' but to demonstrate how one ought to live. What he bequeathed to mankind is his practice: his bearing before the judges, before the guards,

before the accusers and every kind of calumny and mockery – his bearing on the Cross. He does not resist, he does not defend his rights, he takes no steps to avert the worst that can happen to him – more, he provokes it.... And he entreats, he suffers, he loves with those, in those who are doing evil to him. His words to the thief on the Cross contain the whole Evangel. ‘That was verily a divine man, a child of God!’ – says the thief. ‘If thou feelest this’ – answers the redeemer – ‘thou art in Paradise, thou art a child of God.’ Not to defend oneself, not to grow angry, not to make responsible.... But not to resist even the evil man – to love him... 36 – Only we, we emancipated spirits, possess the prerequisite for understanding something nineteen centuries have misunderstood – that integrity become instinct and passion which makes war on the ‘holy lie’ even more than on any other lie.... One has been unspeakably far from our benevolent and cautious neutrality, from that discipline of the spirit through which alone the divining of such strange, such delicate things is made possible: at all times one has, with shameless self-seeking, desired only one’s own advantage in these things, one constructed the Church out of the antithesis to the Gospel. If anyone were looking for a sign that an ironical divinity was at work behind the great universal drama he would find no small support in the tremendous questionmark called Christianity. That mankind should fall on its knees before the opposite of what was the origin, the meaning, the right of the Gospel, that it should have sanctified in the concept ‘Church’ precisely what the ‘bringer of glad tidings’ regarded as beneath him, behind him – one seeks in vain a grander form of worldhistorical irony – 37 – Our age is proud of its historical sense: how was it able to make itself believe in the nonsensical notion that the crude miracle-worker and redeemer fable comes at the commencement of Christianity – and that everything spiritual and symbolic is only a subsequent development? On the contrary: the history of Christianity – and that from the very death on the Cross – is the history of progressively cruder misunderstanding of an original symbolism. With every extension of Christianity over even broader, even ruder masses in whom the preconditions out of which it was born were more and more lacking, it became increasingly necessary to vulgarize, to barbarize Christianity – it absorbed the doctrines and rites of every subterranean cult of the Imperium Romanum, it absorbed the absurdities of every sort of morbid reason. The fate of Christianity lies in the necessity for its faith itself to grow as morbid, low and vulgar as the requirements it was intended to satisfy were morbid, low and vulgar. As the Church, this morbid barbarism itself finally assumes power – the Church, that form of mortal hostility to all integrity, to all loftiness of soul, to discipline of spirit, to all open-hearted and benevolent humanity. – Christian values – noble values: it is only we, we emancipated spirits, who have restored this greatest of all value-antitheses! – 38 – At this point I shall not suppress a sigh. There are days when I am haunted by a feeling blacker than the blackest

melancholy – contempt of man. And so as to leave no doubt as to what I despise, whom I despise: it is the man of today, the man with whom I am fatefully contemporary. The man of today – I suffocate of his impure breath.... With regard to the past I am, like all men of knowledge, of a large tolerance, that is to say a magnanimous self-control: I traverse the madhouse-world of entire millennia, be it called ‘Christianity’, ‘Christian faith’, ‘Christian Church’, with a gloomy circumspection – I take care not to make mankind responsible for its insanities. But my feelings suddenly alter, burst forth, immediately I enter the modern age, our age. Our age knows.... What was formerly merely morbid has today become indecent – it is indecent to be a Christian today. And here is where my disgust commences. – I look around me: there is no longer a word left of what was formerly called ‘truth’, we no longer endure it when a priest so much as utters the word ‘truth’. Even with the most modest claim to integrity one must know today that a theologian, a priest, a pope does not merely err in every sentence he speaks, he lies – that he is no longer free to lie ‘innocently’, out of ‘ignorance’. The priest knows as well as anyone that there is no longer any ‘God’, any ‘sinner’, any ‘redeemer’ – that ‘free will’, ‘moral world-order’ are lies – intellectual seriousness, the profound self-overcoming of the intellect, no longer permits anyone not to know about these things.... All the concepts of the Church are recognized for what they are: the most malicious false-coinage there is for the purpose of devaluing nature and natural values; the priest himself is recognized for what he is: the most dangerous kind of parasite, the actual poison-spider of life.... We know, our conscience knows today – what those sinister inventions of priest and Church are worth, what end they serve, with which that state of human self-violation has brought about which is capable of exciting disgust at the sight of mankind – the concepts ‘Beyond’, ‘Last Judgement’, ‘immortality of the soul’, the ‘soul’ itself: they are instruments of torture, they are forms of systematic cruelty by virtue of which the priest has become master, stays master.... Everyone knows this: and everyone none the less remains unchanged. Where have the last feelings of decency and self-respect gone when even our statesmen, in other ways very unprejudiced kind of men and practical anti-Christians through and through, still call themselves Christians today and go to Communion?... A young prince at the head of his regiments, splendid as the expression of his people’s egoism and presumption – but without any shame professing himself a Christian!... Whom then does Christianity deny? what does it call ‘world’? Being a soldier, being a judge, being a patriot; defending oneself; preserving one’s honour; desiring to seek one’s advantage; being proud.... The practice of every hour, every instinct, every valuation which leads to action is today anti-Christian: what a monster of falsity modern man must be that he is none the less not ashamed to be called a Christian! 39 – To resume, I shall now relate the real history of Christianity. – The word ‘Christianity’ is already a

misunderstanding – in reality there has been only one Christian, and he died on the Cross. The ‘Evangel’ died on the Cross. What was called ‘Evangel’ from this moment onwards was already the opposite of what he had lived: ‘bad tidings’, a dysangel. It is false to the point of absurdity to see in a ‘belief, perchance the belief in redemption through Christ, the distinguishing characteristic of the Christian: only Christian practice, a life such as he who died on the Cross lived, is Christian.... Even today, such a life is possible, for certain men even necessary: genuine, primitive Christianity will be possible at all times.... Not a belief but a doing, above all a not-doing of many things, a different being.... States of consciousness, beliefs of any kind, holding something to be true for example – every psychologist knows, this – are a matter of complete indifference and of the fifth rank compared with the value of the instincts: to speak more strictly, the whole concept of spiritual causality is false. To reduce being a Christian, Christianness, to a holding something to be true, to a mere phenomenality of consciousness, means to negate Christianness. In fact there have been no Christians at all. The ‘Christian’, that which has been called Christian for two millennia, is merely a psychological self-misunderstanding. Regarded more closely, that which has ruled in him, in spite of all his ‘faith’, has been merely the instincts – and what instincts! ‘Faith’ has been at all times, with Luther for instance, only a cloak, a pretext, a screen, behind which the instincts played their game – a shrewd blindness to the dominance of certain instincts.... ‘Faith’ – I have already called it the true Christian shrewdness – one has always spoken of faith, one has always acted from instinct.... The Christian’s world of ideas contains nothing which so much as touches upon actuality: on the other hand, we have recognized in instinctive hatred for actuality the driving element, the only driving element in the roots of Christianity. What follows therefrom? That here, in psychologism also, error is radical, that is to say determinant of the essence, that is to say substance. One concept removed, a single reality substituted in its place – and the whole of Christianity crumbles to nothing! – From a lofty standpoint, this strangest of all facts, a religion not only determined by errors but inventive and even possessing genius only in harmful, only in life-poisoning and heart-poisoning errors, remains a spectacle for the gods – for those divinities which are at the same time philosophers and which I encountered, for example, during those celebrated dialogues on Naxos. In the hour when their disgust leaves them (– and leaves us!) they become grateful for the spectacle of the Christian: perhaps it is only for the sake of this curious case that the pathetic little star called Earth deserves a divine glance and divine participation.... For let us not undervalue the Christian: the Christian, false to the point of innocence, far surpasses the ape – with respect to Christians a well-known theory of descent becomes a mere compliment... 40 – The fate of the Evangel was determined by the death – it hung on the Cross.... It was only the death, this unexpected

shameful death, only the Cross, which was in general reserved for the canaille alone – it was only this terrible paradox which brought the disciples face to face with the real enigma: ‘Who was that? What was that?’ – The feeling of being shaken and disappointed to their depths, the suspicion that such a death might be the refutation of their cause, the frightful question-mark ‘why has this happened?’ – this condition is only too understandable. Here everything had to be necessary, meaningful, reasonable, reasonable in the highest degree; a disciple’s love knows nothing of chance. Only now did the chasm open up: ‘Who killed him? who was his natural enemy?’ – this question came like a flash of lightning. Answer: ruling Judaism, its upper class. From this moment one felt oneself in mutiny against the social order, one subsequently understood Jesus as having been in mutiny against the social order. Up till then this warlike trait, this negative trait in word and deed, was lacking in his image; more, he was the contradiction of it. Clearly the little community had failed to understand precisely the main thing, the exemplary element in his manner of dying, the freedom from, the superiority over every feeling of resentment: – a sign of how little they understood of him at all! Jesus himself could have desired nothing by his death but publicly to offer the sternest test, the proof of his teaching.... But his disciples were far from forgiving his death – which would have been evangelic in the highest sense; not to speak of offering themselves up to a similar death in sweet and gentle peace of heart.... Precisely the most unevangelic of feelings, revengefulness, again came uppermost. The affair could not possibly be at an end with this death: one required ‘retribution’, ‘judgement’ (– and yet what can be more unevangelic than ‘retribution’, ‘punishment’, ‘sitting in judgement’!). The popular expectation of a Messiah came once more into the foreground; an historic moment appeared in view: the ‘kingdom of God’ is coming to sit in judgement on its enemies.... But with this everything is misunderstood: the ‘kingdom of God’ as a last act, as a promise! For the Evangel had been precisely the existence, the fulfilment, the actuality of this ‘kingdom’. Such a death was precisely this ‘kingdom of God’. Only now was all that contempt for and bitterness against Pharisee and theologian worked into the type of the Master – one thereby made of him a Pharisee and theologian! On the other hand, the enraged reverence of these utterly unhinged souls could no longer endure that evangelic equal right of everyone to be a child of God which Jesus had taught, and their revenge consisted in exalting Jesus in an extravagant fashion, in severing him from themselves: just as the Jews, in revenge on their enemies, had previously separated their God from themselves and raised him on high. The one God and the one Son of God: both products of resentment... 41 – And now an absurd problem came up: ‘How could God have permitted that?’ For this question the deranged reason of the little community found a downright terrifyingly absurd answer: God gave his Son for the forgiveness of sins, as a

sacrifice. All at once it was all over with the Gospel! The guilt sacrifice, and that in its most repulsive, barbaric form, the sacrifice of the innocent man for the sins of the guilty! What atrocious paganism! – For Jesus had done away with the concept ‘guilt’ itself – he had denied any chasm between God and man, he lived this unity of God and man as his ‘glad tidings’.... And not as a special prerogative! – From now on there is introduced into the type of the redeemer step by step: the doctrine of a Judgement and a Second Coming, the doctrine of his death as a sacrificial death, the doctrine of the Resurrection with which the entire concept ‘blessedness’, the whole and sole reality of the Evangel, is juggled away – for the benefit of a state after death!... Paul, with that rabbinical insolence which characterizes him in every respect, rationalized this interpretation, this indecency of an interpretation, thus: ‘If Christ is not resurrected from the dead our faith is vain’. – All at once the Evangel became the most contemptible of all unfulfillable promises, the impudent doctrine of personal immortality.... Paul himself even taught it as a reward!... 42 One sees what came to an end with the death on the Cross: a new, an absolutely primary beginning to a Buddhistic peace movement, to an actual and not merely promised happiness on earth. For this remains – I have already emphasized it – the basic distinction between the two *décadence* religions: Buddhism makes no promises but keeps them, Christianity makes a thousand promises but keeps none. – On the heels of the ‘glad tidings’ came the worst of all: those of Paul. In Paul was embodied the antithetical type to the ‘bringer of glad tidings’, the genius of hatred, of the vision of hatred, of the inexorable logic of hatred. What did this dysangelist not sacrifice to his hatred! The redeemer above all: he nailed him to his Cross. The life, the example, the teaching, the death, the meaning and the right of the entire Gospel – nothing was left once this hate-obsessed false-coiner had grasped what alone he could make use of. Not the reality, not the historical truth!... And once more the priestly instinct of the Jew perpetrated the same great crime against history – it simply erased the yesterday and the day before yesterday of Christianity, it devised for itself a history of primitive Christianity. More: it falsified the history of Israel over again so as to make this history seem the pre-history of its act: all the prophets had spoken of its ‘redeemer’.... The Church subsequently falsified even the history of mankind into the pre-history of Christianity.... The type of the redeemer, the doctrine, the practice, the death, the meaning of the death, even the sequel to the death – nothing was left untouched, nothing was left bearing even the remotest resemblance to reality. Paul simply shifted the centre of gravity of that entire existence beyond this existence – in the lie of the ‘resurrected’ Jesus. In fact he could make no use at all of the redeemer’s life – he needed the death on the Cross and something in addition.... To regard as honest a Paul whose home was the principle centre of Stoic enlightenment when he makes of a hallucination the proof that the redeemer is still living, or even to believe his

story that he had this hallucination, would be a real *niaiserie* on the part of a psychologist: Paul willed the end, consequently he willed the means.... What he himself did not believe was believed by the idiots among whom he cast his teaching. – His requirement was power; with Paul the priest again sought power – he could employ only those concepts, teachings, symbols with which one tyrannizes over masses, forms herds. What was the only thing Mohammed later borrowed from Christianity? The invention of Paul, his means for establishing a priestly tyranny, for forming herds: the belief in immortality – that is to say the doctrine of ‘judgement’... 43 If one shifts the centre of gravity of life out of life into the ‘Beyond’ – into nothingness – one has deprived life as such of its centre of gravity. The great lie of personal immortality destroys all rationality, all naturalness of instinct – all that is salutary, all that is life-furthering, all that holds a guarantee of the future in the instincts henceforth excites mistrust. So to live that there is no longer any meaning in living; that now becomes the ‘meaning’ of life.... What is the point of public spirit, what is the point of gratitude for one’s descent and one’s forefathers, what is the point of co-operation, trust, of furthering and keeping in view the general welfare?... So many ‘temptations’, so many diversions from the ‘right road’ – ‘one thing is needful’.... That, as an ‘immortal soul’, everybody is equal to everybody else, that in the totality of beings the ‘salvation’ of every single one is permitted to claim to be of everlasting moment, that little bigots and three-quarters madmen are permitted to imagine that for their sakes the laws of nature are continually being broken – such a raising of every sort of egoism to infinity, to impudence, cannot be branded with sufficient contempt. And yet it is to this pitiable flattery of personal vanity that Christianity owes its victory – it is with this that it has persuaded over to its side everything ill-constituted, rebellious-minded, under-privileged, all the dross and refuse of mankind. ‘Salvation of the soul’ – in plain words: ‘The world revolves around me’... The poison of the doctrine ‘equal rights for all’ – this has been more thoroughly sowed by Christianity than by anything else; from the most secret recesses of base instincts, Christianity has waged a war to the death against every feeling of reverence and distance between man and man, against, that is, the precondition of every elevation, every increase in culture – it has forged out of the resentment of the masses its chief weapon against us, against everything noble, joyful, high-spirited on earth, against our happiness on earth.... ‘Immortality’ granted to every Peter and Paul has been the greatest and most malicious outrage on noble mankind ever committed. – And let us not underestimate the fatality that has crept out of Christianity even into politics! No one any longer possesses today the courage to claim special privileges or the right to rule, the courage to feel a sense of reverence towards himself and towards his equals – the courage for a pathos of distance.... Our politics is morbid from this lack of courage! – The aristocratic outlook has been

undermined most deeply by the lie of equality of souls; and if the belief in the 'prerogative of the majority' makes revolutions and will continue to make them – it is Christianity, let there be no doubt about it, Christian value judgement which translates every revolution into mere blood and crime! Christianity is a revolt of everything that crawls along the ground directed against that which is elevated: the Gospel of the 'lowly' makes low... 44 – The Gospels are invaluable as evidence of the already irresistible corruption within the first community. What Paul later carried to its conclusion with the cynical logic of a rabbi was none the less merely the process of decay which commenced with the death of the redeemer. – One cannot read these Gospels too warily; there are difficulties behind every word. I hope I shall be pardoned for confessing that they are for that very reason a pleasure of the first rank to a psychologist – as the opposite of all kinds of naïve depravity, as refinement par excellence, as artistry in psychological depravity. The Gospels are in a class by themselves. The Bible in general admits of no comparison. One is among Jews: first consideration if one is not to lose the thread completely. This self-pretence of 'holiness', which here becomes downright genius and which has not since been even approximately equalled among books and men, this false-coinage of word and attitude as an art, is not the chance product of some individual talent, some exceptional nature. Race is required for it. In Christianity, as the art of holy lying, the whole of Judaism, a schooling and technique pursued with the utmost seriousness for hundreds of years, attains its ultimate perfection. The Christian, that ultima ratio of the lie, is the Jew once more – even thrice more.... The will to employ as a matter of principle only concepts, symbols, attitudes manifested in the practice of the priest, the instinctive rejection of every other practice, every other kind of perspective in the realm of values and practical application – that is not tradition, it is inheritance: only as inheritance does it have the effect of a natural quality. The whole of mankind, even the finest heads of the finest epochs (with one exception, who is perhaps merely a monster –) have allowed themselves to be deceived. The Gospel has been read as the Book of Innocence.... no small pointer to the degree of histrionic mastery displayed in it. – If we got to see them, to be sure, even if only in passing, all these singular bigots and artificial saints, it would be the end of them – and it is precisely because I never read a word without seeing an attitude that I make an end of them.... They have a way of raising their eyes to Heaven which I cannot endure. – Fortunately books are for most people merely literature. – One must not let oneself be misled: they say 'Judge not!' but they send to Hell everything that stands in their way. By allowing God to judge they themselves judge; by glorifying God they glorify themselves; by demanding precisely those virtues of which they themselves are capable – more, which they are in need of to stay on top at all – they present a great appearance of contending for virtue, of struggling for the triumph of virtue.

‘We live, we die, we sacrifice ourselves for the good’ (– ‘truth’, ‘the light’, the ‘kingdom of God’): in reality they do what they cannot help doing. By making their way in a sneaking fashion, sitting in corners, living out shadowy lives in the shadows, they make a duty of it: their life of humility appears to be a duty, as humility it is one more proof of piety.... Ah this humble, chaste, compassionate mode of mendaciousness! ‘For us virtue itself shall bear witness’.... Read the Gospels as books of seduction by means of morality: these petty people have placed a restraint on morality – they know what use it can be put to! Mankind can best be led by the nose with morality! – The reality is that here the most conscious arrogance of the elect is posing as modesty: one has placed oneself, the ‘community’, the ‘good and just’, once and for all on one side, on the side of ‘truth’ – and the rest, ‘the world’, on the other.... That has been the most fateful kind of megalomania that has ever existed on earth: little abortions of bigots and liars began to lay claim to the concepts ‘God’, ‘truth’, ‘light’, ‘spirit’, ‘love’, ‘wisdom’, ‘life’, as if these were synonyms of themselves so as to divide themselves off from the ‘world’; little superlatives of Jews, ripe for every kind of madhouse, twisted values in general to suit themselves, as if only the ‘Christian’ were the meaning, the salt, the measure and also the ultimate tribunal of all the rest. ... The whole fatality was possible only because there was already in the world a related, racially-related megalomania, the Jewish: once the chasm between Jews and Jewish Christians opened up, the latter were left with no alternative but to employ against the Jews the very self-preservative procedures counselled by the Jewish instinct, while the Jews had previously employed them only against everything nonJewish. The Christian is only a Jew of a ‘freer’ confession. – 45 – I give a few examples of what these petty people have taken into their heads, what they have put into the mouth of their Master: confessions of ‘beautiful souls’ one and all. – ‘And whosoever shall not receive you, nor hear you, when ye depart thence, shake off the dust under your feet for a testimony against them. Verily I say unto you, It shall be more tolerable for Sodom and Gomorrha in the day of judgement, than for that city.’ (Mark vi, 11) – How evangelic!... ‘And whosoever shall offend one of these little ones that believe in me, it is better for him that a millstone were hanged about his neck, and he were cast into the sea.’ (Mark ix, 42) – How evangelic!... ‘And if thine eye offend thee, pluck it out; it is better for thee to enter into the kingdom of God with one eye, than having two eyes to be cast into hell fire: Where their worm death not, and the fire is not quenched.’ (Mark ix, 47–8) – It is not precisely the eye that is meant... ‘Verily I say unto you, That there be some of them that stand here, which shall not taste of death, till they have seen the kingdom of God come with power.’ (Mark ix, 1) – Well lied, lion... ‘Whosoever will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me. For...’ (Observation of a psychologist: Christian morality is refuted by its fors: its ‘reasons’ refute – thus is

it Christian.) (Mark viii, 34–5). ‘Judge not, that ye be not judged. For with what judgement ye judge, ye shall be judged.’ (Matthew vii, 1–2) – What a conception of justice, of a ‘just’ judge!... ‘For if ye love them which love you, what reward have ye? do not even the publicans do the same? And if ye salute your brethren only what do ye more than others? do not even the publicans so?’ (Matthew v, 46–7) – Principle of ‘Christian love’: it wants to be well paid... ‘But if ye forgive not men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.’ (Matthew vi, 15) – Very compromising for the said ‘Father’... ‘But seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you.’ (Matthew vi, 33) – All these things: namely food, clothing, all the essentials of life. An error, to put it mildly.... A little earlier God appears as a tailor, at least under certain circumstances*... ‘Rejoice ye in that day, and leap for joy: for behold, your reward is great in heaven: for in the like manner did their fathers unto the prophets.’ (Luke vi, 23) – Impudent rabble! It already compares itself with the prophets.... ‘Know ye not that ye are the temple of God, and that the Spirit of God dwelleth in you? If any man defile the temple of God, him shall God destroy; for the temple of God is holy, which temple ye are.’ (1 Corinthians iii, 16–17) – Such things as this cannot be sufficiently despised... ‘Do ye not know that the saints shall judge the world? and if the world shall be judged by you, are ye unworthy to judge the smallest matters?’ (1 Corinthians vi, 2) – Unfortunately not merely the ravings of a lunatic.... This frightful impostor goes on to say: ‘Know ye not that we shall judge angels? how much more things that pertain to this life?’... ‘Hath not God made foolish the wisdom of this world? For after that in the wisdom of God the world by wisdom knew not God, it pleased God by the foolishness of preaching to save them that believe...; not many wise men after the flesh, not many mighty, not many noble, are called: But God hath chosen the foolish things of the world to confound the wise; and God hath chosen the weak things of the world to confound the things which are mighty; And base things of the world, and things which are despised, hath God chosen, yea, and things which are not, to bring to naught things that are: That no flesh should glory in his presence.’ (1 Corinthians i, 20 ff.) – To understand this passage, a document of the very first rank for the psychology of every Chandala morality, one should read the first essay of my *Genealogy of Morals*, where the antithesis between a noble morality and a Chandala morality born of resentment and impotent revengefulness is first brought to light. Paul was the greatest of all apostles of revenge... 46 – What follows from all this? That one does well to put gloves on when reading the New Testament. The proximity of so much uncleanness almost forces one to do so. One would no more choose to associate with ‘first Christians’ than one would with Polish Jews: not that one would need to prove so much as a single point against them.... Neither of them smell very pleasant. – I have looked in vain for so much as one sympathetic trait

in the New Testament; there is nothing free, benevolent, open-hearted, honest in it. Humanity has not taken its first step here – the instincts of cleanliness are lacking.... There are only bad instincts in the New Testament, there is not even the courage for these bad instincts. Everything in it is cowardice, everything is self-deception and closing one's eyes to oneself. Every book becomes clean if one has just read the New Testament: to give an example, immediately after reading Paul I read with delight that sweetest and most highspirited of all mockers, Petronius, of whom one could say what Domenico Boccaccio wrote to the Duke of Parma of Cesare Borgia: 'è tutto festo' – immortally healthy, immortally cheerful and well-constituted.... For these little bigots miscalculate in the main thing. They attack, but everything attacked by them is thereby signalized. Whomever a 'first Christian' attacks is not besmirched by it.... Conversely: it is an honour to have 'first Christians' against one. It is impossible to read the New Testament without feeling a partiality for that which is ill-treated in it – to say nothing of the 'wisdom of this world' which an impudent humbug tried in vain to confound.... But even the Scribes and Pharisees gain advantage from having such an opponent: they must have been worth something to be hated in such an indecent fashion. Hypocrisy – that's rich coming from 'first Christians'! – The Scribes and Pharisees were the privileged: this sufficed, Chandala hatred requires no further reasons. The 'first Christian' – and, I fear, also the 'last Christian', whom I shall perhaps live to see – is a rebel in his lowest instincts against everything privileged – he always lives and struggles for 'equal rights'.... More closely considered, he has no choice. If one wants to be, in one's own person, 'chosen of God' – or a 'temple of God', or a 'judge of angels' – then every other principle of selection, for example on the basis of integrity, intellect, manliness and pride, beauty and liberality of heart, is simply 'world' – evil as such.... Moral: every word in the mouth of a 'first Christian' is a lie, every act he performs an instinctive falsehood – all his values, all his aims are harmful, but whomever he hates, whatever he hates, has value.... The Christian, the priestly Christian especially, is a criterion of values. – Do I still have to add that in the entire New Testament there is only one solitary figure one is obliged to respect? Pilate, the Roman governor. To take a Jewish affair seriously – he cannot persuade himself to do that. One Jew more or less – what does it matter?... The noble scorn of a Roman before whom an impudent misuse of the word 'truth' was carried on has enriched the New Testament with the only expression which possesses value – which is its criticism, its annihilation even: 'What is truth?'... 47 – What sets us apart is not that we recognize no God, either in history or in nature or behind nature – but that we find that which has been revered as God not 'godlike' but pitiable, absurd, harmful, not merely an error but a crime against life.... We deny God as God.... If this God of the Christians were proved to us to exist, we should know even less how to believe in him. – In a formula:

Deus, qualem Paulus creavit, dei negation.* – A religion like Christianity, which is at no point in contact with actuality, which crumbles away as soon as actuality comes into its own at any point whatever, must naturally be a mortal enemy of the ‘wisdom of the world’, that is to say of science – it will approve of all expedients by which disciplining of the intellect, clarity and severity in matters of intellectual conscience, noble coolness and freedom of intellect, can be poisoned and calumniated and brought into ill repute. ‘Faith’ as an imperative is a veto against science – in praxi the lie at any cost.... Paul understood the need for the lie, for ‘faith’; the Church subsequently understood Paul. – That God which Paul invented for himself, a God who ‘confounds the wisdom of the world’ (in a narrower sense the two great opponents of all superstition, philology and medicine), is in reality only the resolute determination of Paul himself to do so: to call one’s own will ‘God’ Torah† – that is quintessentially Jewish. Paul wants to confound the ‘wisdom of the world’: his enemies are the good philologists and physicians of the Alexandrian school – upon them he makes war. In fact, one is not philologist and physician without also being at the same time anti-Christian. For as philologist one sees behind the ‘sacred books’, as physician behind the physiological depravity of the typical Christian. The physician says ‘incurable’, the philologist ‘fraud’... 48 – Has the famous story which stands at the beginning of the Bible really been understood – the story of God’s mortal terror of science;?... It has not been understood. This priest’s-book begins, as is only proper, with the priest’s great inner difficulty: he has only one great danger, consequently ‘God’ has only one great danger. – The old God, all ‘spirit’, all high priest, all perfection, promenades in his garden: but he is bored. Against boredom the gods themselves fight in vain.* What does he do? He invents man – man is entertaining.... But behold, man too is bored. God’s sympathy with the only kind of distress found in every Paradise knows no bounds: he forthwith creates other animals. God’s first blunder: man did not find the animals entertaining – he dominated them, he did not even want to be an ‘animal’. – Consequently God created woman. And then indeed there was an end to boredom – but also to something else! Woman was God’s second blunder. – ‘Woman is in her essence serpent, Heva’ – every priest knows that; ‘every evil comes into the world through woman’ – every priest knows that likewise. ‘Consequently, science too comes into the world through her’.... Only through woman did man learn to taste the tree of knowledge. – What had happened? A mortal terror seized on the old God. Man himself had become God’s greatest blunder; God had created for himself a rival, science makes equal to God – it is all over with priests and gods if man becomes scientific! – Moral: science is the forbidden in itself – it alone is forbidden. Science is the first sin, the germ of all sins, original sin. This alone constitutes morality. – ‘Thou shalt not know’ – the rest follows. – God’s mortal terror did not stop him from being shrewd. How can one defend oneself against

science? – that was for long his chief problem. Answer: away with man out of Paradise! Happiness, leisure gives room for thought – all thoughts are bad thoughts.... Man shall not think. – And the ‘priest in himself invents distress, death, the danger to life in pregnancy, every kind of misery, age, toil, above all sickness – nothing but expedients in the struggle against science! Distress does not allow man to think.... And none the less! oh horror! the structure of knowledge towers up, heaven-storming, reaching for the divine – what to do! – The old God invents war, he divides the peoples, he makes men destroy one another (– priests have always had need of war...). War – among other things a great mischief-maker in science! – Incredible! knowledge, emancipation from the priest, increases in spite of wars. – And the old God comes to a final decision: ‘Man has become scientific – there is nothing for it, he will have to be drowned!’ ... 49 – Have I been understood? The beginning of the Bible contains the entire psychology of the priest. – The priest knows only one great danger: that is science – the sound conception of cause and effect. But science flourishes in general only under happy circumstances – one must have a superfluity of time and intellect in order to ‘know’.... ‘Consequently man must be made unhappy’ – this has at all times been the logic of the priest. – One will already have guessed what only came into the world therewith, in accordance with this logic – ‘sin’.... The concept of guilt and punishment, the entire ‘moral world-order’, was invented in opposition to science – in opposition to the detaching of man from the priest.... Man shall not look around him, he shall look down into himself; he shall not look prudently and cautiously into things in order to learn, he shall not look at all: he shall suffer.... And he shall suffer in such a way that he has need of the priest at all times. – Away with physicians! One has need of a Saviour. – The concept of guilt and punishment, including the doctrine of ‘grace’, of ‘redemption’, of ‘forgiveness’ – lies through and through and without any psychological reality – were invented to destroy the causal sense of man: they are an outrage on the concept cause and effect! – And not an outrage with the fist, with the knife, with honest hatred and love! But one from the most cowardly, cunning, lowest instincts! An outrage of the priest! An outrage of the parasite! A vampirism of pale subterranean bloodsuckers!... When the natural consequences of an act are no longer ‘natural’ but thought of as effected by the conceptual ghosts of superstition, by ‘God’, by ‘spirits’, by ‘souls’, as merely ‘moral’ consequences, as reward, punishment, sign, chastisement, then the precondition for knowledge has been destroyed – then one has committed the greatest crime against humanity. – Sin, to say it again, that form par excellence of the self-violation of man, was invented to make science, culture, every kind of elevation and nobility of man impossible; the priest rules through the invention of sin. – 50 – At this point I cannot absolve myself from giving an account of the psychology of ‘belief, of ‘believers’, for the use, as is only reasonable, of precisely the

‘believers’ them selves. If there is today still no lack of those who do not know how indecent it is to ‘believe’ – or a sign of *décadence*, of a broken will to live – well, they will know it tomorrow. My voice reaches even the hard-of-hearing. – It appears, if I have not misheard, that there exists among Christians a kind of criterion of truth called ‘proof by potency’. ‘Belief makes blessed: therefore it is true.’ – One might here object straight away that this making-blessed itself is not proved but only promised: blessedness conditional upon ‘believing’ – one shall become blessed because one believes.... But that what the priest promises the believer for a ‘Beyond’ inaccessible to any control actually occurs, how could that be proved? – The alleged ‘proof by potency’ is therefore at bottom only a further belief that the effect which one promises oneself from the belief will not fail to appear. In a formula: ‘I believe that belief makes blessed – consequently it is true’. – But with that we have already reached the end of the argument. This ‘consequently’ would be the *absurdum* itself as a criterion of truth. – But if, with no little indulgence, we suppose that the fact that belief makes blessed be regarded as proved (– not merely desired, not merely promised by the somewhat suspect mouth of a priest): would blessedness – more technically, pleasure – ever be a proof of truth? So little that it provides almost the counterproof, at any rate the strongest suspicion against ‘truth’, when feelings of pleasure enter into the answer to the question ‘what is true?’ The proof by ‘pleasure’ is a proof of pleasure – that is all; when on earth was it established that true judgements give more enjoyment than false ones and, in accordance with a predetermined harmony, necessarily bring pleasant feelings in their train? – The experience of all severe, all profound intellects teaches the reverse. Truth has had to be fought for every step of the way, almost everything else dear to our hearts, on which our love and our trust in life depend, has had to be sacrificed to it. Greatness of soul is needed for it: the service of truth is the hardest service. – For what does it mean to be honest in intellectual things? That one is stern towards one’s heart, that one despises ‘fine feelings’, that one makes every Yes and No a question of conscience! – Belief makes blessed: consequently it lies... 51 That under certain conditions belief makes blessed, that blessedness does not turn an *idée fixe* into a true idea, that faith moves no mountains but surely places mountains where there are none: a fleeting visit to a madhouse will provide ample enlightenment on these things. Not, I admit, to a priest: for he denies by instinct that sickness is sickness, that a madhouse is a madhouse. Christianity needs sickness almost as much as Hellenism needs a superfluity of health – making sick is the true hidden objective of the Church’s whole system of salvation procedures. And the Church itself – is it not the Catholic madhouse as an ultimate ideal? – The whole earth as a madhouse? – The religious man as the Church desires him to be is a typical *décadent*; the moment when a religious crisis has gained the upper hand of a people is always characterized by epidemics of neurosis; the ‘inner world’ of the

religious man is so like the ‘inner world’ of the over-excited and exhausted as to be mistaken for it; the ‘highest’ states which Christianity has hung up over mankind as the most valuable of all values are forms of epilepsy – the Church has canonized only lunatics or great imposters in majorem deum honorem.*... I once permitted myself to describe the entire Christian penance-and-redemption training (which can be studied best today in England) as a methodically induced folie circulaire, naturally on a soil already prepared for it, that is to say a thoroughly morbid soil. No one is free to become a Christian or not to do so; one is not ‘converted’ to Christianity – one must be sufficiently sick for it.... We others, who have the courage for health and also for contempt, what contempt we have for a religion which teaches misunderstanding of the body! which does not wish to get rid of the soul-superstition! which makes a ‘merit’ of eating too little! which combats health as a kind of enemy, devil, temptation! which has persuaded itself that a ‘perfect soul’ could be carried about in a cadaver of a body and to do so needed to concoct a new conception of ‘perfection’, a pale, sickly, idiot-fanatic condition, so-called ‘holiness’ – holiness itself merely a symptom-syndrome of the impoverished, enervated, incurably corrupted body!... As a European movement, the Christian movement has been from the very first a collective movement of outcast and refuse elements of every kind (– these want to come to power through Christianity). It is not the expression of the decline of a race, it is an aggregate formation of *décadence* types from everywhere crowding together and seeking one another out. It is not, as is generally believed, the corruption of antiquity itself, of noble antiquity, which made Christianity possible: the learned idiocy which even today maintains such a thing cannot be contradicted too severely. The period in which the morbid, corrupt Chandala classes of the entire Imperium were becoming Christian was precisely that in which the opposing type, the nobility, existed in its fairest and maturest form. The majority became master; the democratism of the Christian instincts conquered.... Christianity was not ‘national’, not racially conditioned – it turned to the disinherited of life of every kind, it had its allies everywhere. Christianity has at its basis the rancune of the sick, the instinct directed against the healthy, against health. Everything well-constituted, proud, high-spirited, beauty above all, is hurtful to its ears and eyes. I recall again the invaluable saying of Paul: ‘God hath chosen the weak things of the world, the foolish things of the world, base things of the world and things which are despised’: that was the formula, in hoc signo *décadence* conquered. – God on the Cross – is the fearful hidden meaning behind this symbol still understood? – Everything that suffers, everything that hangs on the Cross, is divine.... We all hang on the Cross, consequently we are divine.... We alone are divine.... Christianity was a victory, a nobler disposition perished by it – Christianity has been up till now mankind’s greatest misfortune. – 52 Christianity also stands in opposition to all intellectual

well-constitutedness – it can use only the morbid mind as the Christian mind, it takes the side of everything idiotic, it proclaims a curse against the ‘spirit’, against the superbia of the healthy spirit. Because sickness belongs to the essence of Christianity, the typical Christian condition, ‘faith’, has to be a form of sickness, every straightforward, honest, scientific road to knowledge has to be repudiated by the Church as a forbidden road. Even to doubt is a sin.... The complete lack of psychological cleanliness in the priest – it betrays itself in his glance – is a consequent phenomenon of *décadence* – one can observe in hysterical women and rickety children how regularly instinctive falsity, lying for the sake of lying, inability to look straight and act straight, are expressions of *décadence*. ‘Faith’ means not wanting to know what is true. The pietist, the priest of both sexes, is false because he is sick: his instinct demands that truth shall not come into its own at any point. ‘What makes sick is good; what proceeds from abundance, from superfluity, from power, is evil’: that is what the believer feels. Compulsion to lie – in that I detect every predestined theologian. – Another mark of the theologian is his incapacity for philology. Philology is to be understood here in a very wide sense as the art of reading well – of being able to read off a fact without falsifying it by interpretation, without losing caution, patience, subtlety in the desire for understanding. Philology as *ephexis** in interpretation: whether it be a question of books, newspaper reports, fate or the weather – to say nothing of the ‘salvation of the soul’.... The way in which a theologian, no matter whether in Berlin or in Rome, interprets a ‘word of the Scriptures’, or an experience, a victory of his country’s army for example, under the higher illumination of the psalms of David, is always so audacious as to make a philologist run up every wall in sight. And what on earth is he to do when pietists and other cows out of Swabia dress up the pathetic commonplace and stuffiness of their existence with the ‘finger of God’ into a miracle of ‘grace’, of ‘divine providence’, of ‘experience of salvation’! Yet the most modest expenditure of intelligence, not to say decency, would convince these interpreters of the complete childishness and unworthiness of such an abuse of divine dexterity.* Even the slightest trace of piety in us ought to make us feel that a God who cures a headcold at the right moment or tells us to get into a coach just as a downpour is about to start is so absurd a God he would have to be abolished even if he existed. A God as a domestic servant, as a postman, as an almanac-maker – at bottom a word for the stupidest kind of accidental occurrence.... ‘Divine providence’, as it is still believed in today by almost every third person in ‘cultured Germany’, would be a stronger objection to God than any other that could possibly be thought of. And in any case it is an objection to the Germans!... 53 – That martyrs prove anything about the truth of a cause is so little true I would be disposed to deny that a martyr has ever had anything whatever to do with truth. In the tone with which a martyr throws his opinion at

the world's head there is already expressed so low a degree of intellectual integrity, such obtuseness to the question of 'truth', that one never needs to refute a martyr. Truth is not something one person might possess and another not possess: peasants at the most, or peasant apostles like Luther, could think of truth in this fashion. One may be certain that modesty, moderation in intellectual matters, increases with the degree of conscientiousness in them. To know five things and gently decline to know anything else.... 'Truth' as every prophet, every sectarian, every latitudinarian, every Socialist, every Churchman understands the word, is conclusive proof that not so much as a start has been made on that disciplining of the intellect and selfovercoming necessary for the discovery of any truth, even the very smallest. – Martyrdoms, by the way, have been a great misfortune in history: they have seduced.... The inference of all idiots, women and nations included, that a cause for which someone is willing to die (not to speak of those which, like primitive Christianity, produce epidemics of death-seeking) must have something in it – this inference has become an unspeakable drag on verification, on the spirit of verification and caution. Martyrs have harmed truth.... And even today a crude sort of persecution is all that is required to create an honourable name for any sect, no matter how indifferent in itself. – What? does the fact that someone gives up his life for it change anything in the value of a cause? – An error which becomes honourable is an error which possesses one seductive charm more: do you believe, messieurs the theologians, that we would give you an opportunity of becoming martyrs for your lies? – one refutes a thing by laying it respectfully on ice – just so does one refute theologians too.... The world-historical stupidity of all persecutors has lain precisely in giving their opponents the appearance of honourableness – in bestowing on them the fascination of martyrdom.... Woman is today on her knees before an error because she has been told someone died on the Cross for it. Is the Cross then an argument? – But on all these things one man alone has said the word that has been wanting for millennia – Zarathustra. They wrote letters of blood on the path they followed and their folly taught that truth is proved by blood. But blood is the worst witness of truth; blood poisons and transforms the purest teaching to delusion and hatred of the heart. And if someone goes through fire for his teaching – what does that prove? Truly, it is more when one's own teaching comes out of one's own burning!* 54 One should not let oneself be misled: great intellects are sceptics. Zarathustra is a sceptic. The vigour of a mind, its freedom through strength and superior strength, is proved by scepticism. Men of conviction simply do not come into consideration where the fundamentals of value and disvalue are concerned. Convictions are prisons. They do not see far enough, they do not see things beneath them: but to be permitted to speak about value and disvalue one must see five hundred convictions beneath one – behind one.... A spirit which wants to do great things, which also wills the

means for it, is necessarily a sceptic. Freedom from convictions of any kind, the capacity for an unconstrained view, pertains to strength.... Grand passion, the ground and force of his being, even more enlightened, more despotic than he himself is, takes his whole intellect into its service; it makes him intrepid; it even gives him the courage for unholy means; if need be it permits him convictions. Conviction as a means: there is much one can achieve only by means of a conviction. Grand passion uses and uses up convictions, it does not submit to them – it knows itself sovereign. – Conversely: the need for belief, for some unconditional Yes and No, Carlylism if I may be excused the expression, is a requirement of weakness. The man of faith, the ‘believer’ of every sort is necessarily a dependent man – such as cannot out of himself posit ends at all. The ‘believer’ does not belong to himself, he can be only a means, he has to be used, he needs someone who will use him. His instinct accords the highest honour to a morality of selflessness: everything persuades him to it, his intelligence, his experience, his vanity. Belief of any kind is itself an expression of selflessness, of self-alienation.... If one considers what need people have of an external regulation to constrain and steady them, how compulsion, slavery in a higher sense, is the sole and final condition under which the person of weaker will, woman especially, can prosper; then one also understands the nature of conviction, ‘faith’. Conviction is the backbone of the man of conviction. Not to see many things, not to be impartial in anything, to be party through and through, to view all values from a strict and necessary perspective – this alone is the condition under which such a man exists at all. But he is thereby the antithesis, the antagonist of the truthful man – of truth.... The believer is not free to have a conscience at all over the question ‘true’ and ‘false’: to be honest on this point would mean his immediate destruction. The pathological conditionality of his perspective makes of the convinced man a fanatic – Savonarola, Luther, Rousseau, Robespierre, Saint-Simon – the antithetical type of the strong, emancipated spirit. But the larger-than-life attitudes of these sick spirits, these conceptual epileptics, impresses the great masses – fanatics are picturesque, mankind would rather see gestures than listen to reasons... 55 – A further step in the psychology of conviction, of ‘belief. I suggested long ago that convictions might be more dangerous enemies of truth than lies. This time I should like to pose the decisive question: is there any difference whatever between a lie and a conviction? – All the world believes there is, but what does all the world not believe! – Every conviction has its history, its preliminary forms, its tentative shapes, its blunders: it becomes a conviction after not being one for a long time, after hardly being one for an even longer time. What? could the lie not be among these embryonic forms of conviction? – Sometimes it requires merely a change in persons: in the son that becomes conviction which in the father was still a lie. – I call a lie: wanting not to see something one does see, wanting not to see

something as one sees it: whether the lie takes place before witnesses or without witnesses is of no consequence. The most common lie is the lie one tells to oneself; lying to others is relatively the exception. – Now this desiring not to see what one sees, this desiring not to see as one sees, is virtually the primary condition for all who are in any sense party: the party man necessarily becomes a liar. German historiography, for example, is convinced that Rome was despotism, that the Teutons brought the spirit of freedom into the world: what difference is there between this conviction and a lie? Is there any further need to be surprised if all parties, German historians included, instinctively have the big moral words in their mouths – that morality continues to exist virtually because the party man of every sort has need of it every moment? – ‘This is our conviction: we confess it before all the world, we live and die for it – respect everything that has convictions!’ – I have heard this kind of thing even from the lips of anti-Semites. On the contrary, gentlemen! An anti-Semite is certainly not made more decent by the fact that he lies on principle.... The priests, who are subtler in such things and understand very well the objection that can be raised to the concept of a conviction, that is to say mendaciousness on principle because serving a purpose, have taken over from the Jews the prudence of inserting the concept ‘God’, ‘the will of God’, ‘the revelation of God’ in its place. Kant too, with his categorical imperative, was on the same road: his reason became practical in this matter. – There are questions whose truth or untruth cannot be decided by man; all the supreme questions, all the supreme problems of value are beyond human reason.... To grasp the limits of reason – only this is truly philosophy.... To what end did God give mankind revelation? Would God have done anything superfluous? Mankind cannot of itself know what is good and what evil, therefore God taught mankind his will.... Moral: the priest does not lie – the question ‘true’ or ‘untrue’ does not arise in such things as priests speak of; these things do not permit of lying at all. For in order to lie one would have to be able to decide what is true here. But this is precisely what mankind cannot do; the priest is thus only God’s mouthpiece. – This kind of priestly syllogism is by no means only Jewish and Christian; the right to lie and the shrewdness of a ‘revelation’ pertains to the type priest, to priests of *décadence* as much as to priests of paganism (– pagans are all who say Yes to life, to whom ‘God’ is the word for the great Yes to all things). – The ‘Law’, the ‘will of God’, the ‘sacred book’, ‘inspiration’ – all merely words for the conditions under which the priest comes to power, by which he maintains his power, these concepts are to be found at the basis of all priestly organizations, all priestly or priestly-philosophical power-structures. The ‘holy lie’ – common to Confucius, the Law-Book of Manu, Mohammed, the Christian Church – : it is not lacking in Plato. ‘The truth exists’: this means, wherever it is heard, the priest is lying... 56 – Ultimately the point is to what end a lie is told. That ‘holy’ ends are lacking in Christianity is

my objection to its means. Only bad ends: the poisoning, slandering, denying of life, contempt for the body, the denigration and self-violation of man through the concept sin – consequently its means too are bad. – It is with an opposite feeling that I read the Law – Book of Manu, an incomparably spiritual and superior work, so much as to name which in the same breath as the Bible would be a sin against the spirit. One sees immediately that it has a real philosophy behind it, in it, not merely an ill – smelling Jewish acidity compounded of rabbinism and superstition – it gives even the most fastidious psychologist something to bite on. Not forgetting the main thing, the basic difference from any sort of Bible: it is the means by which the noble orders, the philosophers and the warriors, keep the mob under control; noble values everywhere, a feeling of perfection, an affirmation of life, a triumphant feeling of well-being in oneself and of goodwill towards life – the sun shines on the entire book. – All the things upon which Christianity vents its abysmal vulgarity, procreation for example, woman, marriage, are here treated seriously, with reverence, with love and trust. How can one actually put into the hands of women and children a book containing the low-minded saying: ‘To avoid fornication let every man have his own wife, and let every woman have her own husband... for it is better to marry than burn’?*

And is it allowable to be a Christian as long as the origin of man is Christianized, that is to say dirtied, with the concept of the immaculata conceptio?... I know of no book in which so many tender and kind remarks are addressed to woman as in the Law-Book of Manu; these old greybeards and saints have a way of being polite to women which has perhaps never been surpassed. ‘A woman’s mouth’ – it says in one place – ‘a girl’s breast, a child’s prayer, the smoke of a sacrifice are always pure’. Another passage: ‘There is nothing purer than the light of the sun, the shadow of a cow, air, water, fire and a girl’s breath.’ A final passage – perhaps also a holy lie – : ‘All the openings of the body above the navel are pure, all below impure. Only in the case of a girl is the whole body pure.’ 57 One catches the unholiness of the Christian means in flagranti when one compares the Christian purpose with the purpose of the Manu Law-Book – when one throws a bright light on this greatest of antitheses of purpose. The critic of Christianity cannot be spared the task of making Christianity contemptible. – Such a law-book as that of Manu originates as does every good law-book: it summarizes the experience, policy and experimental morality of long centuries, it settles accounts, it creates nothing new. The precondition for a codification of this sort is the insight that the means of endowing with authority a truth slowly and expensively acquired are fundamentally different from those by which one would demonstrate it. A lawbook never tells of the utility of a law, of the reason for it, of the casuistry which preceded it: for in that way it would lose the imperative tone, the ‘thou shalt’, the precondition of being obeyed. The problem lies precisely in this. – At a certain point in the evolution of a people its most

enlightened, that is to say most reflective and far-sighted, class declares the experience in accordance with which the people is to live – that is, can live – to be fixed and settled. Their objective is to bring home the richest and completest harvest from the ages of experimentation and bad experience. What, consequently, is to be prevented above all is the continuation of experimenting, the perpetuation in infinitum of the fluid condition of values, tests, choices, criticizing of values. A two-fold wall is erected against this: firstly revelation, that is the assertion that the reason for these laws is not of human origin, was not sought and found slowly and with many blunders, but, being of divine origin, is whole, perfect, without history, a gift, a miracle, merely communicated.... Then tradition, that is, the assertion that the law has already existed from time immemorial, that it is impious, a crime against the ancestors, to call it in question. The authority of the law is established by the thesis: God gave it, the ancestors lived it. – The higher rationale of such a procedure lies in the intention of gradually making the way of life recognized as correct (that is demonstrated by a tremendous amount of finely-sifted experience) unconscious: so that a complete automatism of instinct is achieved – the precondition for any kind of mastery, any kind of perfection in the art of living. To set up a law-book of the kind of *Manu* means to concede to a people the right henceforth to become masterly, to become perfect – to be ambitious for the highest art of living. To that end the law must be made unconscious: this is the purpose of every holy lie. – The order of castes, the supreme, the dominating law, is only the sanctioning of a natural order, a natural law of the first rank over which no arbitrary caprice, no ‘modern idea’ has any power. In every healthy society, there can be distinguished three types of man of divergent physiological tendency which mutually condition one another and each of which possesses its own hygiene, its own realm of work, its own sort of mastery and feeling of perfection. Nature, not *Manu*, separates from one another the predominantly spiritual type, the predominantly muscular and temperamental type, and the third type distinguished neither in the one nor the other, the mediocre type – the last as the great majority, the first as the *élite*. The highest caste – I call it the very few – possesses, as the perfect caste, also the privileges of the very few: among them is that of representing happiness, beauty, benevolence on earth. Only the most spiritual human beings are permitted beauty, beautiful things: only in their case is benevolence not weakness. *Pulchrum est paucorum hominum*: the good is a privilege. On the other hand, nothing is more strictly forbidden them than ugly manners or a pessimistic outlook, an eye that makes ugly – to say nothing of indignation at the collective aspect of things. Indignation is the privilege of the *Chandala*; pessimism likewise. ‘The world is perfect’ – thus speaks the instinct of the most spiritual, the affirmative instinct – : ‘imperfection, everything beneath us, distance between man and man, the pathos of this distance, the *Chandala* themselves

pertain to this perfection'. The most spiritual human beings, as the strongest, find their happiness where others would find their destruction: in the labyrinth, in severity towards themselves and others, in attempting; their joy lies in self-constraint: with them asceticism becomes nature, need, instinct. They consider the hard task a privilege, to play with vices which overwhelm others a recreation.... Knowledge – a form of asceticism. – They are the most venerable kind of human being: this does not exclude their being the most cheerful, the most amiable. They rule not because they want to but because they are; they are not free to be second in rank. – The second in rank: these are the guardians of the law, the keepers of order and security; the noble warriors; above all the king as the highest formula of warrior, judge and upholder of the law. The second in rank are the executives of the most spiritual order, the closest to them who relieve them of everything coarse in the work of ruling – their following, their right hand, their best pupils. – In all this, to say it again, there is nothing capricious, nothing 'artificial'; whatever is different from this is artificial – nature is then confounded.... The order of castes, order of rank, only formulates the supreme law of life itself; the separation of the three types is necessary for the preservation of society, for making possible higher and higher types – inequality of rights is the condition for the existence of rights at all. – A right is a privilege. The privilege of each is determined by the nature of his being. Let us not underestimate the privileges of the mediocre. Life becomes harder and harder as it approaches the heights – the coldness increases, the responsibility increases. A high culture is a pyramid: it can stand only on a broad base, its very first prerequisite is a strongly and soundly consolidated mediocrity. The crafts, trade, agriculture, science, the greater part of art, in a word the entire compass of professional activity, are in no way compatible with anything other than mediocrity in ability and desires; these things would be out of place among the élite, the instinct pertaining to them is as much opposed to aristocracy as it is to anarchy. To be a public utility, a cog, a function, is a natural vocation, it is not society, it is the kind of happiness of which the great majority are alone capable, which makes intelligent machines of them. For the mediocre it is happiness to be mediocre; mastery in one thing, specialization, is for them a natural instinct. It would be quite unworthy of a more profound mind to see an objection in mediocrity as such. It is even the prime requirement for the existence of exceptions; a high culture is conditional upon it. When an exceptional human being handles the mediocre more gently than he does himself or his equals, this is not mere politeness of the heart* – it is simply his duty.... Whom among today's rabble do I hate the most? The Socialist rabble, the Chandala apostles who undermine the worker's instinct, his pleasure, his feeling of contentment with his little state of being – who make him envious, who teach him revengefulness.... Injustice never lies in unequal rights, it lies in the claim to

‘equal’ rights.... What is bad? But I have already answered that question: everything that proceeds from weakness, from envy, from revengefulness. – The anarchist and the Christian have a common origin... 58 It does indeed make a difference for what purpose one lies: whether one preserves with a lie or destroys with it. One may assert an absolute equivalence between Christian and anarchist: their purpose, their instinct is set only on destruction. For the proof of this proposition one has only to read history, which displays it with frightful clarity. If we have just now examined a religious legislation the purpose of which was to ‘eternalize’ a grand organization of society, the supreme condition for the prosperity of life – Christianity discovered its mission in making an end of just such an organization because life prospered within it. There the revenue of reason from long ages of experimentation and uncertainty was to be employed for the benefit of the most distant future and the biggest, richest, most complete harvest possible brought home: here, on the contrary, the harvest was poisoned overnight.... That which stood aere perennius, the Imperium Romanum, the most grandiose form of organization under difficult conditions which has hitherto been achieved, in comparison with which everything before and everything since is patchwork, bungling, dilettantism – these holy anarchists made it an ‘act of piety’ to destroy ‘the world’, that is to say the Imperium Romanum, until not one stone was left standing on another – until even Teutons and other such ruffians could become master of it.... The Christian and the anarchist: both *décadents*, both incapable of producing anything but dissolution, poisoning, degeneration, both bloodsuckers, both with the instinct of deadly hatred towards everything that stands erect, that towers grandly up, that possesses duration, that promises life a future.... Christianity was the vampire of the Imperium Romanum – the tremendous deed of the Romans in clearing the ground for a great culture which could take its time was undone overnight by Christianity. – Is this still not understood? The Imperium Romanum which we know, which the history of the Roman province teaches us to know better and better, this most admirable of all works of art in the grand style, was a beginning, its structure was calculated to prove itself by millennia – to this day there has never been such building, to build in such a manner *sub specie aeterni* has never been so much as dreamed of! – This organization was firm enough to endure bad emperors: the accident of persons must have no effect on such things – first principle of all grand architecture. But it was not firm enough to endure the corruptest form of corruption, to endure the Christian.... These stealthy vermin which, shrouded in night, fog and ambiguity crept up to every individual and sucked seriousness for real things, the instinct for realities of any kind, out of him, this cowardly, womanish and honeyed crew gradually alienated the ‘souls’ of this tremendous structure – those precious, those manly-noble natures who found their own cause, their own seriousness, their own pride in the cause of Rome. This underhanded

bigotry, conventicle secrecy, gloomy concepts such as Hell, such as the sacrifice of the innocent, such as the unio mystica in blood-drinking, above all the slowly stirred-up fire of revengefulness, of Chandala revengefulness – that is what became master of Rome, the same species of religion on whose antecedent form Epicurus had already made war. One must read Lucretius to understand what it was Epicurus opposed: not paganism but ‘Christianity’, which is to say the corruption of souls through the concept of guilt, punishment and immortality. – He opposed the subterranean cults, the whole of latent Christianity – to deny immortality was already in those days a real redemption. – And Epicurus would have won, every mind of any account in the Roman Empire was an Epicurean: then Paul appeared.... Paul, Chandala hatred against Rome, against ‘the world’, become flesh and genius, the Jew, the eternal Jew* par excellence.... What he divined was that with the aid of the little sectarian movement on the edge of Judaism one could ignite a ‘world conflagration’, that with the symbol ‘God on the Cross’ one could sum up everything down-trodden, everything in secret revolt, the entire heritage of anarchist agitation in the Empire into a tremendous power. ‘Salvation is of the Jews.’ – Christianity as the formula for outbidding all the subterranean cults, those of Osiris, of the Great Mother, of Mithras for example – and for summing them up: it is in this insight that the genius of Paul consists. His instinct in this matter was so sure that, doing ruthless violence to the truth, he took the ideas by which those Chandala religions exercised their fascination and placed them in the mouth of the ‘Saviour’ he had invented, and not only in his mouth – so as to make of him something even a priest of Mithras could understand.... This was his vision on the road to Damascus: he grasped that to disvalue ‘the world’ he needed the belief in immortality, that the concept ‘Hell’ will master even Rome – that with the ‘Beyond’ one kills life.... Nihilist and Christian: they rhyme,* and do not merely rhyme... 59 The whole labour of the ancient world in vain: I have no words to express my feelings at something so dreadful. – And considering its labour was a preparation, that only the substructure for a labour of millennia had, with granite selfconfidence, been laid, the whole meaning of the ancient world in vain!... Why did the Greeks exist? Why the Romans? – Every prerequisite for an erudite culture, all the scientific methods were already there, the great, the incomparable art of reading well had already been established – the prerequisite for a cultural tradition, for a uniform science; natural science, in concert with mathematics and mechanics, was on the best possible road – the sense for facts, the last-developed and most valuable of all the senses, had its schools and its tradition already centuries old! Is this understood? Everything essential for setting to work had been devised – methods, one must repeat ten times, are the essential, as well as being the most difficult, as well as being that which has habit and laziness against it longest. What we have won back for ourselves today with an unspeakable amount of self-

constraint – for we all still have bad instincts, the Christian instincts, somewhere within us – the free view of reality, the cautious hand, patience and seriousness in the smallest things, the whole integrity of knowledge – was already there! already more than two millennia ago! And good and delicate taste and tact! Not as brain training! Not as ‘German’ culture with the manners of ruffians! But as body, as gesture, as instinct – in a word, as reality.... All in vain! Overnight merely a memory! – Greeks! Romans! nobility of instinct, of taste, methodical investigation, genius for organization and government, the faith in, the will to a future for mankind, the great Yes to all things, visibly present to all the senses as the Imperium Romanum, grand style no longer merely art but become reality, truth, life.... And not overwhelmed overnight by a natural event! Not trampled down by Teutons and other such clodhoppers! But ruined by cunning, secret, invisible, anaemic vampires! Not conquered – only sucked dry!... Covert revengefulness, petty envy become master ! Everything pitiful, everything suffering from itself, everything tormented by base feelings, the whole ghetto-world of the soul suddenly on top! – One has only to read any of the Christian agitators, Saint Augustine for example, to realize, to smell, what dirty fellows had therewith come out on top. One would be deceiving oneself utterly if one presupposed a lack of intelligence of any sort on the part of the leaders of the Christian movement – oh they are shrewd, shrewd to the point of holiness, these Church Fathers! What they lack is something quite different. Nature was neglectful when she made them – she forgot to endow them with even a modest number of respectable, decent, cleanly instincts.... Between ourselves, they are not even men.... If Islam despises Christianity, it is a thousand times right to do so: Islam presupposes men... 60 Christianity robbed us of the harvest of the culture of the ancient world, it later went on to rob us of the harvest of the culture of Islam. The wonderful Moorish cultural world of Spain, more closely related to us at bottom, speaking more directly to our senses and taste, than Greece and Rome, was trampled down (– I do not say by what kind of feet –): why? because it was noble, because it owed its origin to manly instincts, because it said Yes to life even in the rare and exquisite treasures of Moorish life!... Later on, the Crusaders fought against something they would have done better to lie down in the dust before – a culture compared with which even our nineteenth century may well think itself very impoverished and very ‘late’. – They wanted booty, to be sure: the Orient was rich.... But let us not be prejudiced! The Crusades – higher piracy, that is all! German knighthood, Viking knighthood at bottom, was there in its element: the Church knew only too well what German knighthood can be had for.... The German knights, always the ‘Switzers’ of the Church, always in the service of all the bad instincts of the Church – but well paid.... That it is precisely with the aid of German swords, German blood and courage, that the Church has carried on its deadly war against everything noble on earth! A host of

painful questions arises at this point. The German aristocracy is virtually missing in the history of higher culture: one can guess the reason.... Christianity, alcohol – the two great means of corruption.... For in itself there should be no choice in the matter when faced with Islam and Christianity, as little as there should when faced with an Arab and a Jew. The decision is given in advance; no one is free to choose here. One either is Chandala or one is not.... ‘War to the knife with Rome! Peace, friendship with Islam’: this is what that great free spirit, the genius among German emperors, Friedrich the Second, felt, this is what he did. What? does a German have to be a genius, a free spirit, before he can have decent feelings? How a German could ever have felt Christian escapes me... 61 Here it is necessary to touch on a memory a hundred times more painful for Germans. The Germans have robbed Europe of the last great cultural harvest Europe had to bring home – of the harvest of Renaissance. Is it at last understood, is there a desire to understand, what the Renaissance was? The revaluation of Christian values, the attempt, undertaken with every expedient, with every instinct, with genius of every kind, to bring about the victory of the opposing values, the noble values.... Up till now this has been the only great war, there has been no more decisive interrogation than that conducted by the Renaissance – the question it asks is the question I ask – : neither has there been a form of attack more fundamental, more direct, and more strenuously delivered on the entire front and at the enemy’s centre! To attack at the decisive point, in the very seat of Christianity, to set the noble values on the throne, which is to say to set them into the instincts, the deepest needs and desires of him who sits thereon.... I see in my mind’s eye a possibility of a quite unearthly fascination and splendour – it seems to glitter with a trembling of every refinement of beauty, there seems to be at work in it an art so divine, so diabolically divine, that one might scour the millennia in vain for a second such possibility; I behold a spectacle at once so meaningful and so strangely paradoxical it would have given all the gods of Olympus an opportunity for an immortal roar of laughter – Cesare Borgia as Pope.... Am I understood?... Very well, that would have been a victory of the only sort I desire today – : Christianity would thereby have been abolished! – What happened? A German monk, Luther, went to Rome. This monk, all the vindictive instincts of a failed priest in him, fulminated in Rome against the Renaissance.... Instead of grasping with profound gratitude the tremendous event which had taken place, the overcoming of Christianity in its very seat – his hatred grasped only how to nourish itself on this spectacle. The religious man thinks only of himself. – What Luther saw was the corruption of the Papacy, while precisely the opposite was palpably obvious: the old corruption, the peccatum originale, Christianity no longer sat on the Papal throne! Life sat there instead! the triumph of life! the great Yes to all lofty, beautiful, daring things!... And Luther restored the Church: he attacked it.... The Renaissance – an event

without meaning, a great in vain! – Oh these Germans, what they have already cost us! In vain – that has always been the work of the Germans. – The Reformation; Leibniz; Kant and so-called German philosophy; the Wars of ‘Liberation’; the Reich – each time an in vain for something already in existence, for something irretrievable.... They are my enemies, I confess it, these Germans: I despise in them every kind of uncleanness of concept and value, of cowardice in the face of every honest Yes and No. For almost a millennium they have twisted and tangled everything they have laid their hands on, they have on their conscience all the half-heartedness – three-eighths-heartedness! – from which Europe is sick – they also have on their conscience the uncleanest kind of Christianity there is, the most incurable kind, the kind hardest to refute, Protestantism.... If we never get rid of Christianity, the Germans will be to blame... 62 – With that I have done and pronounce my judgement. I condemn Christianity, I bring against the Christian Church the most terrible charge any prosecutor has ever uttered. To me it is the extremest thinkable form of corruption, it has had the will to the ultimate corruption conceivably possible. The Christian Church has left nothing untouched by its depravity, it has made of every value a disvalue, of every truth a lie, of every kind of integrity a vileness of soul. People still dare to talk to me of its ‘humanitarian’ blessings! To abolish any state of distress whatever has been profoundly inexpedient to it: it has lived on states of distress, it has created states of distress in order to eternalize itself.... The worm of sin, for example: it was only the Church which enriched mankind with this state of distress! – ‘Equality of souls before God’, this falsehood, this pretext for the rancune of all the base-minded, this explosive concept which finally became revolution, modern idea and the principle of the decline of the entire social order – is Christian dynamite.... ‘Humanitarian’ blessings of Christianity! To cultivate out of humanitas a self-contradiction, an art of self-violation, a will to falsehood at any price, an antipathy, a contempt for every good and honest instinct! These are the blessings of Christianity! – Parasitism as the sole practice of the Church; with its ideal of green-sickness, of ‘holiness’ draining away all blood, all love, all hope for life; the Beyond as the will to deny reality of every kind; the Cross as the badge of recognition for the most subterranean conspiracy there has ever been – a conspiracy against health, beauty, wellconstitutedness, bravery, intellect, benevolence of soul, against life itself... Wherever there are walls I shall inscribe this eternal accusation against Christianity upon them – I can write in letters which make even the blind see.... I call Christianity the one great curse, the one great intrinsic depravity, the one great instinct for revenge for which no expedient is sufficiently poisonous, secret, subterranean, petty – I call it the one immortal blemish of mankind... And one calculates time from the dies nefastus* on which this fatality arose – from the first day of Christianity! – Why not rather from its last? – From today? –

Revaluation of all values! Glossary of Names ARISTOTLE (384–322 BC) Nietzsche has only a slight interest in Aristotle, and his main concern with him is to refute his conception of tragedy as catharsis; the ‘magnanimous’ man of the Nicomachean Ethics, however, is very like Nietzsche’s *Übermensch*. AUGUSTINE (354–430) ‘These have mastered Christianity:... Platonism (Augustine)...’ (Will to Power 214); utterly unable to live in the manner of Jesus, Augustine employed Christianity as a vehicle for his own ideology in the manner of Paul. BAUDELAIRE, Charles (1821–67) ‘Who was the first intelligent supporter of Wagner? Charles Baudelaire....’ (Ecce Homo II 5): Nietzsche’s interest in Baudelaire, such as it is, is part of his interest in proving that Wagner was at bottom a French *décadent*. BORGIA, Cesare (d. 1507) ‘Borgia’ is an ideogram for the man of strong but unsublimated will to power, the ‘blond beast’, who is not ‘improved’ when he is tamed. BUCKLE, Henry Thomas (1821–62) Historian, author of the unfinished History of Civilization in which he expounds his ideas on the general laws which govern the evolution of human societies. His reputation formerly stood much higher than it does now: in the Genealogy of Morals (1, 4) Nietzsche attacks the ‘plebeianism of the modern spirit’ as manifested in the ‘notorious case of Buckle’. BURCKHARDT, Jacob (1818–97) Historian, best known for his Civilization of the Renaissance in Italy. He was an elder colleague of Nietzsche’s at Basel university and Nietzsche retained a great admiration for him. CAESAR, Julius (101–44 BC) In Nietzsche’s works, Caesar is dehistoricized into an ideogram for the man of sublimated will to power (compare Borgia). Nietzsche does admire Caesar, but not specifically as a general and certainly not because he was a general (compare Napoleon). CARLYLE, Thomas (1795–1881) In an aphorism in Dawn called ‘The cult of hero- worship and its fanatics’ (298), Nietzsche says of one who idealizes another that he ‘sets this person at so great a distance from himself that he can no longer see him clearly – and then he reinterprets what he still sees into the “beautiful”, which is to say the symmetrical, soft-lined, indefinite.’ The two men he accuses of doing this, Byron and Carlyle, are both as it happens Scotsmen, and it was another Scotsman, Thomas Campbell, who provided the formula for this kind of perspective in the lines, ‘’Tis distance lends enchantment to the view, And robes the mountain in its azure hue’ and thereby defined a good part of ‘Romanticism’. To Nietzsche, Carlyle was a ‘typical Romantic’. CATILINE, Lucius Sergius (c. 109–62 BC) Unsuccessful conspiracy against the Senate 63–2 BC: his feelings towards that body are likened to Caesar’s, his handling of that body contrasted with Caesar’s. COMTE, Auguste (1798–1857) French philosopher, author of the Cours de philosophie positive (1830–42). Comte was for Nietzsche the great ‘embracer and conqueror of the pure sciences’ who at the end of his life allowed his scientific strictness to evaporate into ‘poetical mist and mystic lights’ (Dawn 542). CORNARO, Luigi (1467–1566)

After surviving a nearly fatal illness at forty, he advocated a sparing diet as a recipe for health and long life. 'In later life he found one egg a day sufficient solid food.' (Encyclopedia Britannica). His book, *Discorsi sulla vita sobria* (1558), was a best-seller in many languages. DANTE ALIGHIERI (1265–1321) The scattered references to Dante in Nietzsche's works are highly contradictory. DARWIN, Charles (1809–82) Confrontation with Darwin is a major motif of Nietzsche's philosophy passim. There are four main points at issue: (i) in so far as 'Darwinism' means the theory of evolution it is 'true but deadly' because it proves that mankind is a continuation of the animals and that human life is therefore deprived of any special significance; Nietzsche's hypothesis of sublimated will to power is designed to restore a distinction between man and animal; (ii) in so far as Darwinism is the theory of evolution by natural selection brought about by a 'struggle for survival' it is, Nietzsche maintains, untrue, because it presupposes a niggardliness and state of chronic distress in nature which does not exist, the state of nature being on the contrary 'one of superfluity and prodigality, even to the point of absurdity' (*The Gay Science* 349: the unconscious influence on Darwin's theory of the condition of nineteenth-century England and of Victorian middle-class thriftiness and money-mindedness in general is now, I think, generally recognized); (iii) in as much as the effects accounted for by the hypothesis of a will to aggrandizement include those accounted for by the hypothesis of a 'will to survive' this latter hypothesis is superfluous; (iv) when a 'struggle for survival' does take place its outcome is not that implied by the theory of natural selection, that is to say it is not a higher type which emerges victorious. DEMOCRITUS (flourished c. 420 BC) Greek philosopher, the founder, with Leucippus, of atomism. Nietzsche's attitude towards Democritus' atomism is instructive: he approves of its materialism and of the fact that it can get along without any teleology, but he sees that it is very far from being the complete victory over Parmenides its advocates took it to be: the projection of the notion of a 'subject' from the individual on to the outside world, where it assumes the shape of a 'thing', is certainly not done away with in atomism, for the 'atom' is a 'thing'. The mechanistic idea of atoms as solid objects like billiard balls was instinctively rejected by Nietzsche: and in *Human, All Too Human* (19) he wrote: 'the whole procedure of science has been pursuing the task of resolving everything thing-like (material) into motions.' DESCARTES, René (1596–1650) In his relatively few references to Descartes, Nietzsche is chiefly concerned to question the validity of Descartes' dictum *cogito, ergo sum*, mainly by way of analysing the proposition 'I think'. This has less to do with Descartes himself than with Nietzsche's general polemic against 'the foisting on of a "subject"'. DOSTOYEVSKY, Fyodor (1821–81) 'A few weeks ago I did not even know the name of Dostoyevsky.... A chance reach in a bookshop brought to my notice a work just translated into French, L'esprit

souterrain [Notes from Underground] ... The instinct of kinship (or what shall I call it?) spoke immediately, my joy was extraordinary: I have to go back to my becoming acquainted with Stendhal's *Rouge et Noir* to recall another such joy.' (Letter of 23 February 1887.) By 7 March he had also read *The House of the Dead* and *The Insulted and Injured*, both likewise in French translation. Whether he read all or any of the four great novels is unknown: in view of his continued enthusiasm for Dostoyevsky his failure to mention any of them in his considerable correspondence of 1887 and 1888 suggests he did not, although one is almost compelled to conclude that the employment of the word 'idiot' to describe Jesus, as well as its rather frequent employment in the works in 1888 in general, derives from a knowledge of Dostoyevsky's *The Idiot*: certainly an awareness of what Dostoyevsky means by that term helps us to understand why Nietzsche should have used it. Since he was twenty-three years younger than Dostoyevsky and produced many of his books after Dostoyevsky was dead, it is important to note how late it was before he came to read him: what suggests Dostoyevsky in Nietzsche's writings before 1887 is not the product of influence or borrowing but of a similarity in psychological acumen. ELIOT, George (Mary Ann Evans, 1819–80) Nietzsche's friend Helene Druscowicz was a great admirer of George Eliot, wrote about her and talked to Nietzsche about her. Fräulein Druscowicz could read English (she translated Swinburne into German), Nietzsche could not, or only very haltingly, and it seems likely he knew of George Eliot mainly from her: he clearly thought of Eliot mainly as an English free-thinker. The reference to her in *Twilight* is the only one in Nietzsche's works. EMERSON, Ralph Waldo (1803–82) Aphorism 92 of *The Gay Science*, on the relation between poetry and prose, names the only four 'masters of prose' of the nineteenth century (Goethe being considered a product of the eighteenth): Leopardi, Mérimée, Emerson and Landor. Whatever one may think of this judgement, and of its somewhat narrow conception of what constitutes good prose, it provides evidence of Nietzsche's extreme admiration for Emerson. The original edition of *The Gay Science* (1882) is prefaced by a quotation from Emerson, and he admired Emerson longer and with greater consistency than he did any other contemporary writer: his holiday programme for 1862 included making extracts from all Emerson's essays (no record of whether he actually did so) and his enthusiasm is just as great in 1888. EPICURUS (341–270 BC) Greek philosopher, adopted the physics and the ethical teaching of Democritus and made of the latter the influential moral doctrine named after him. For Nietzsche, 'the garden god' Epicurus is a mood rather than a man: aphorism 295 of *The Wanderer and his Shadow*, in which Epicurus is called 'one of the greatest human beings, the inventor of an heroic-idyllic mode of philosophizing', is a description of this mood. FONTENELLE, Bernard Le Bovier de (1657–1757) French writer. He appears here as a representative of the group of six – the others are

Montaigne, La Rochefoucauld, La Bruyère, Vauve-nargues and Chamfort – of whom Nietzsche says (*The Wanderer and his Shadow* 214) that one is closer to antiquity when reading them than with any similar group of any other nation: ‘Their books... contain more actual ideas than all the books of German philosophers put together.’ FRIEDRICH THE SECOND (1194–1250) King of Sicily from 1198, king of Germany from 1212, ‘emperor of the West’ from 1220; continually in conflict with the Papacy; although excommunicated he took part in the sixth crusade, when he negotiated with the Mohammedans instead of fighting them and gained the city of Jerusalem without bloodshed. His court in Sicily was possibly the most cultured spot in Europe, and Friedrich himself, although the ‘German Christian emperor’, was more of a Mohammedan than a Christian and more of an Italian than a German. The need to be continually on the defensive against the forces of the Pope produced a deterioration in his character in later years which ended in a species of persecution mania. Nietzsche’s admiration for him is unqualified and it is interesting to see why: ‘the first European according to my taste’ (*Beyond Good and Evil* 200) he calls him at the end of a discussion of the possibility that higher types of men are produced as a consequence of racial mixture: it is Friedrich’s cosmopolitan culture which Nietzsche admires, the ‘good European’. (In expressing his admiration for Friedrich the Second Nietzsche is probably also expressing his lack of admiration for the traditionally admired Friedrich the First, called Barbarossa.) GOETHE, Johann Wolfgang (1749–1832) The modern man Nietzsche admired most and the one who provided him with a yardstick against which he measured the achievements of other men; a type of the *Übermensch* or ‘Dionysian man’. The description of Goethe in ‘Expeditions of an Untimely Man’ 49 defines the *Übermensch* more succinctly than any other single passage in Nietzsche’s works. GONCOURT, Edmond (1822–96) and Jules (1830–70) French writers of the naturalist school. ‘The second volume of the journal des Goncourts has appeared... in it are described in the most vivid way the celebrated dinners chez Magny, those dinners which brought together every fortnight the wittiest and most sceptical company of Parisian spirits of the time (Sainte-Beuve, Flaubert, Théophile Gautier, Taine, Renan, the Goncourts, Schérer, Gavarni, occasionally Turgenev, etc.). Exasperated pessimism, cynicism, nihilism, alternating with much boisterousness and good humour; I myself wouldn’t be at all out of place there – I know these gentlemen inside out, so well that I have really had enough of them already. One has to be more radical: fundamentally they all lack the main thing – “la force”.’ (Letter of 10 November 1887). HARTMANN, Eduard von (1842–1906) German philosopher, author of *Philosophy of the Unconscious*. Often referred to by Nietzsche, always with contempt. HEGEL, Georg Wilhelm Friedrich (1770–1831) Nietzsche’s relation to Hegel is complex and cannot be satisfactorily described in a note. Two things can be noted, however: (i) Nietzsche’s basic

attitude towards Hegel was that his philosophy was the conceptual basis of modern 'evolutionism' and thus encouraged a habit of mind which ought to be deprecated; (ii) Nietzsche clearly did not study Hegel very profoundly and was in many ways closer to him than he suspected, although he acknowledged that 'we Germans would be Hegelians even if Hegel had never existed, in as much as we instinctively accord a profounder significance and a greater value to becoming and evolution than we do to that which "is"....' (The Gay Science 357.) HEINE, Heinrich (1797–1856) German-Jewish poet and writer. 'The highest conception of the lyric poet was given me by Heinrich Heine. I seek in vain in all the realms of the millennia for an equally sweet arid passionate music. He possessed that divine malice without which I cannot conceive the perfect. – I estimate the value of human beings, of races, according to how necessarily they do not know how to understand the god apart from the satyr. – And how he handles German! It will one day be said that Heine and I have been by far the greatest artists of the German language...' (Ecce Homo II 4.) HERACLITUS (c. 500 BC) Greek philosopher. Because of his dynamic view of nature much admired by Nietzsche. In his pride and isolation, and the sibylline character of his utterances, he is the ultimate model for Zarathustra. HORACE (Quintus Horatius Flaccus, 65–8 BC) Often quoted by Nietzsche, although sometimes the quotations are only familiar tags, e.g. *aereperennius*. HUGO, Victor (1802–85) 'Victor Hugo and Richard Wagner – they signify one and the same thing: that in declining cultures, that wherever the decision comes to rest with the masses, genuineness becomes superfluous, disadvantageous, an encumbrance. Only the actor still arouses great enthusiasm.' (The Wagner Case II.) KANT, Emmanuel (1724–1804) There are scores of references to Kant in Nietzsche's works, and the greater part of them are hostile. What Nietzsche held against Kant can, however, be stated in a single sentence: that Kant believed in and sought to demonstrate the existence of a 'moral world-order'. LEIBNIZ, Gottfried Wilhelm (1646–1716) Nietzsche credits Leibniz with and praises him for the discovery that 'what we call consciousness constitutes only a condition of our spiritual and psychical world (perhaps a morbid condition) and is very far from constituting this world itself' (The Gay Science 357): the connexion with Nietzsche's speculations will be clear. Otherwise he has little interest in Leibniz. LISZT, Franz (1811–86), 'who excels all other musicians in the nobility of his orchestral tone' (Ecce Homo II 7) – but because he was Wagner's father-in-law Nietzsche cannot resist making jokes about him. Liszt was, of course, very much an 'actor' in Nietzsche's sense of the word. LOBECK, Christian August (1781–1860) German philologist and antiquary; a specialist in the history of the Greek language. He wrote many scholarly works. LUTHER, Martin (1483–1546) The long polemic in The Anti-Christ against 'faith' as the distinguishing characteristic of the Christian expresses what lies behind Nietzsche's long-standing enmity towards

Luther: emphasis on 'faith' is merely a confession of incapacity for 'works'. Nietzsche also continually emphasizes Luther's coarseness and his enmity towards reason. MACHIAVELLI, Niccolò (1469–1527) Admired by Nietzsche for his 'realism'; but Nietzsche refers to him very infrequently and there seems no good reason for linking their names as is sometimes done. MALTHUS, Thomas Robert (1766–1834) 'Population, when unchecked, increases in a geometrical ratio. Subsistence only increases in an arithmetical ratio... the power of population is indefinitely greater than the power in the earth to produce subsistence for man.' (Essay on the Principle of Population [1798].) MICHELET, Jules (1798–1874) Historian of France and of the Revolution. Nietzsche links him with Schiller and Carlyle as an idealizing historian. (Will to Power 343.) MILL, John Stuart (1806–74) Very few references to Mill in Nietzsche's works, but many hostile ones to 'utilitarianism', which was especially Mill's ethical theory. NAPOLEON BONAPARTE (1769–1821) Not, despite occasional suggestions to the contrary, a type of the Übermensch, but a 'synthesis of Unmensch [monster] and Übermensch' (Genealogy of Morals I 16) – that is to say, a 'problem'. Nietzsche worries this problem of Napoleon from the beginning of his life till the end, but arrives at no definite conclusion. Many of his statements about Napoleon are neutral as regards 'admiration' or 'dislike': they seek to describe. He shows no interest in his military campaigns and his assessment of him does not involve consideration of his generalship. PASCAL, Blaise (1623–62) French mathematician and philosopher. At the age of sixteen he wrote a treatise on conic sections and at eighteen invented a computer; later he invented, among other things, the calculus of probability and the hydraulic press. On the night of 23 November 1654 he suffered a mystical 'conversion' to religious belief and from then on frequented Port-Royal and devoted himself largely to religious controversy and to introspective philosophizing and meditation (his celebrated *Pensées*). Nietzsche mentions Pascal dozens of times, and always with reference to this religious conversion and its consequences: he is 'the most instructive of all sacrifices to Christianity'. (Ecce Homo II 3.) PETRONIUS, Caius (suicide AD 65) Author of the *Satyricon*, a satire in prose and verse on the social life of first century Rome. PLATO (428–347 BC) 'Plato against Homer: that is the whole, the genuine antagonism' (Genealogy of Morals III 25): the former as a slanderer of life, the latter as its glorifier. Nietzsche's attitude becomes comprehensible in the light of his own 'materialism', for in that light Plato becomes a falsifier of reality. Nietzsche considered Plato's theory of suprasensible forms, his ethical preoccupation and his other-worldly tendency in general as harmful to a healthy appreciation of the present world and as specific errors springing from a false relationship with the actual world: Plato is one of those who need to 'lie themselves out of reality'. RENAN, Ernest (1823–92) French rationalist writer: the type of free-thinker who has not really freed himself

from religion. ROUSSEAU, Jean-Jacques (1712–78) In his essay *Schopenhauer as an Educator* (the third of the *Untimely Meditations*, 1874), Nietzsche offers a comparison between Rousseau and Goethe, the former representing the revolutionary man and the latter the contemplative, and in ‘Expeditions of an Untimely Man’ 48 and 49 he contrasts them again. Goethe is now, of course, much more than the contemplative man: he is, in fact, the superman, the embodiment of sublimated will to power; and Rousseau too has undergone a change, this time for the worse: from the revolutionary he has declined to the rabble, and is in fact the representative of unsublimated will to power. Nietzsche’s long polemic against Rousseau – there are dozens of references to him – can best be understood in the light of this symbolism: Rousseau’s ‘back to nature’ means back to the animals, back to passion uncontrolled. SAINT-SIMON, Claude-Henri, Comte de (1760–1825) Inventor of an economic theory involving common ownership of property and distribution of goods: the Saint-Simonians acquired rather quickly some of the characteristics of religious fanaticism. SAINTE-BEUVE, Charles-Augustin (1804–69) Very influential literary critic and historian. Nietzsche criticizes, here and elsewhere, his celebrated ‘objectivity’. SALLUST (86–c.35 BC) Latin historian; chronicled the Catiline conspiracy. He modelled his style on that of Thucydides. SAND, George (Aurore Dupin, Baroness Dudevant, 1804–76) Novelist and writer. ‘It betrays corruption of the instincts – quite apart from the fact that it betrays bad taste – when a woman appeals precisely to Madame Roland or Madame de Staël or Monsieur George Sand as if something in favour of “woman as such” were thereby demonstrated. Among men the above-named are the three comic women as such – nothing more! – and precisely the best involuntary counter-arguments against emancipation and female autocracy.’ (*Beyond Good and Evil* 233.) SCHILLER, Friedrich (1759–1805) As a youth Nietzsche was a Schiller enthusiast; he lost his enthusiasm as he grew older. From that he concluded that Schiller was essentially something for young people (this opinion is expressed several times in his works). Ultimately he considered Schiller superficial and Romantic. SCHOPENHAUER, Arthur (1788–1860) His *World as Will and Idea* (1818) was a major influence on the young Nietzsche, who for many years considered himself a ‘Schopenhauerian’: but Schopenhauer’s pessimism, his duality of will and intellect, his metaphysical preoccupation and his hostility towards the emotions, particularly sexuality, were none of them finally acceptable and Nietzsche’s mature philosophy is not indebted to Schopenhauer in any way. His youthful discipleship is, however, the reason for the frequency with which the older Nietzsche makes polemical points against Schopenhauer. SOCRATES (470–399 BC) ‘Socrates... stands so close to me that I am almost always fighting with him’, Nietzsche confessed in the notes for an uncompleted essay of 1875 (*Wissenschaft und Weisheit in Kampf*) and the fight went on until

the end. Socrates is the type of 'the philosopher' and in investigating the mind and heart of Socrates Nietzsche is investigating his own: with none of the figures he discusses is the tremendous inner dialectic of Nietzsche's lifelong monologue so clearly displayed as it is in the passages dealing with Socrates (of which there are hundreds). The 'problem' of Socrates is the problem of reason, of the status of reason in the life of man: and Nietzsche finds that problem inexhaustible.

SPENCER, Herbert (1820–1903) Philosopher of evolution. Nietzsche never refers to him without disdain. SPINOZA, Baruch (1632–77) On five main points, Nietzsche says in a letter of 30 July 1881, he finds that he and Spinoza are in agreement: on denying free will, purpose, the moral world-order, the unegoistic and the existence of evil. But he deprecates 'that hocus-pocus of mathematical form with which Spinoza encased his philosophy as if in brass'. (Beyond Good and Evil 5.)

STENDHAL (Henri Beyle, 1783–1842) Greatly admired by Nietzsche for his psychological insight and as an 'honest atheist... Perhaps I am even envious of Stendhal? He has robbed me of the best atheist joke, which precisely I could have made: "God's only excuse is that he does not exist."' (Ecce Homo II 3.)

STRAUSS, David (1808–74) His *Life of Jesus* and *The Old Faith and the New* were very popular expositions of the rationalist approach to religion. The first of Nietzsche's *Untimely Meditations* – David Strauss, the Confessor and the Writer (1873) – was a violent attack on him.

THUCYDIDES (c. 460–c. 395 BC) Greek historian, author of the *History of the Peloponnesian War*.

TOLSTOY, Leo (1828–1910) *Décadent* because of his emphasis on 'pity'. (Genealogy of Morals III 26, Will to Power 1020.) That 'resist not evil' is the key to the Gospel may have been suggested to Nietzsche by Tolstoy (see Tolstoy's *My Religion*, chapter I), but the conclusions he draws from this have nothing to do with Tolstoy.

WAGNER, Richard (1813–83) As a youth Nietzsche was deeply under Wagner's influence; around 1876 he broke away, but the figure of Wagner continued to haunt him and there is an unceasing dialogue between the two in Nietzsche's works almost *passim*. In the mature Nietzsche, Wagner is the type of 'the artist'. He plays a relatively minor role in *Twilight* because an entire book *The Wagner Case*, had just been devoted to him; but later in the year 1888 he comes to the forefront again in Nietzsche *contra* Wagner.

WINCKELMANN, Johann Joachim (1717–68) Archaeologist and historian of art whose conception of ancient Greece became the accepted one for the German world throughout the eighteenth century. Goethe's view of the ancient world derived from Winckelmann, whose writings he studied and whom he celebrated in *Winckelmann and his Century* (1805).

ZOLA, Emile (1840–1902) 'There is no such thing as pessimistic art.... Art affirms, Job affirms. – But Zola? But the Goncourts? – The things they exhibit are ugly: but that they exhibit them comes from pleasure in this ugliness....' (Will to Power 821.)

CHRONOLOGY 15 October. Friedrich Wilhelm Nietzsche born in the parsonage

at Röcken, near Lützen, Germany, the first of three children of Karl 1844 Ludwig, the village pastor, and Fraziska Nietzsche, daughter of the pastor of a nearby village. 1849 27 July. Nietzsche's father dies. 1850 The Nietzsche family moves to Naumberg, in Thuringia, in April. Arthur Schopenhauer publishes *Essays, Aphorisms and Maxims*. 1856 Birth of Freud. 1858 The family moves to No. 18 Weingarten. Nietzsche wins a place at the prestigious Pforta grammar school. Forms a literary society, 'Germania', with two Naumberg friends. 1860 Jacob Burckhardt publishes *The Civilization of the Renaissance in Italy*. 1864 Enters Bonn University as a student of theology and philology. At Easter, Nietzsche abandons the study of theology having lost his 1865 Christian belief. Leaves Bonn for Leipzig, following his former tutor of philology, Friedrich Ritschl. Begins to read Schopenhauer. First publication, 'Zur Geschichte der Theognideischen 1867 Spruchsammlung' (The History of the Theognidia Collection) in the *Rheinische Museum für Philologie*. Begins military service. 1868 Discharged from the army. Meets Richard Wagner. Appointed to the chair of classical philology at Basle University 1869 having been recommended by Ritschl. Awarded a doctorate by Leipzig. Regular visitor at Wagners' home in Tribschen. Delivers public lectures on 'The Greek Music Drama' and 'Socrates 1870 and Tragedy'. Serves as a medical orderly with the Prussian army where he is taken ill with diphtheria. Applies unsuccessfully for the chair of philology at Basle. His health 1871 deteriorates. Takes leave to recover and works on *The Birth of Tragedy*. 1872 *The Birth of Tragedy* published (January). Public lectures 'On the Future of our Educational Institutions'. 1873 *Untimely Meditations I: David Strauss* published. 1874 *Untimely Meditations II: On the Use and Disadvantage of History for Life and III: Schopenhauer as Educator* published. 1875 Meets Peter Gast, who is to become his earliest 'disciple'. Suffers from ill-health leading to a general collapse at Christmas. Granted a long absence from Basle due to continuing ill-health. Proposes marriage to Mathilde Trampedach but is rejected. *Untimely Meditations IV: Richard Wagner in Bayreuth* published. Travels to Italy. 1878 *Human, All Too Human* published. His friendship with the Wagners comes to an end. 1879 *Assorted Opinions and Maxims* published. Retires on a pension from Basle due to sickness. 1880 *The Wanderer and his Shadow* and *Human, All Too Human II* published. 1881 *Dawn* published. 1882 *The Gay Science* published. Proposes to Lou Andreas Salomé and is rejected. 1883 13 February. Wagner dies in Venice. Thus Spoke Zarathustra I and II published. 1884 Thus Spoke Zarathustra III published. 1885 Zarathustra IV privately printed. 1886 *Beyond Good and Evil* published. 1887 *On the Genealogy of Morals* published. *The Wagner Case* published. First review of his work as a whole 1888 published in the *Bern Bund*. Experiences some improvement in health but this is short-lived. Suffers mental collapse in Turin and is admitted to a psychiatric 1889 clinic at the University of Jena. Twilight of

the Idols published and Nietzsche contra Wagner privately printed. 1890 Nietzsche returns to his mother's home. 1891 Dithyramps of Dionysus published. 1894 The Anti-Christ published. The 'Nietzsche Archive' founded by his sister, Elisabeth. 1895 Nietzsche contra Wagner published. 1897 20 April. Nietzsche's mother dies; and Elisabeth moves Nietzsche to Weimar. 1900 25 August. Nietzsche dies. Freud publishes Interpretation of Dreams. 1901 Publication of The Will to Power, papers selected by Elisabeth and Peter Gast. 1908 Ecce Homo published. * jeder 'Fall' ein GlÜcksfall. 'Fall' means case, 'Glücksfall' a piece of good luck. As well as being a play on words there seems to be a reference intended to Der Fall Wagner (The Wagner Case), Nietzsche's witty attack on Wagner completed immediately before Twilight was begun and which was also announced, ironically of course, as a 'relief' from a sterner task. † The spirit grows, strength is restored by wounding. * Like The Wagner Case, presumably. † See the Translator's Note, page 26. * Suche Nullen! 'Nullen' means nobodies, ciphers, as well as noughts – 'Seek nobodies!' The aphorism is a pun: 'if you want to multiply yourself by 100 [have followers] get noughts [nobodies] behind you!' † Zeitgemässe. Nietzsche's conception of himself as Unzeitgemäss (untimely, inopportune, independent of the age) is reflected in the chapter title 'Expeditions of an Untimely Man' (Streifzüge eines Unzeitgemässen), which itself refers back to Unzeitgemässe Betrachtungen (Untimely Meditations), the collective title of four essays published 1873 – 6 and intended for others left incomplete. ‡ bread and Circe, in place of panem et circenses = bread and circuses. * Refers to a popular adage deriving from Johann Gottfried Seume's poem Die Gesänge. † Geist. All the meanings contained in this word cannot be conveyed in a single English word: what is meant is spirit, mind, intellect, intelligence. I have translated it as 'spirit', 'spiritual' when the most inclusive sense seems indicated, as 'intellect', 'intellectual' when this seems more appropriate. ‡ i.e. since the establishment of the Reich. § contradiction in terms. || Gewissensbisse (conscience-bites) is the ordinary term for pangs of conscience. * Der getretene Wurm krümmt sich plays upon the German equivalent of 'Even a worm will turn'. † Refers to the traditional misreading of a line in Ernst Moritz Arndt's patriotic song Des deutschen Vaterland: 'So with die deutsche Zunge klingt, Und Gott in Himmel Lieder singt'. 'Gott' is dative: Wherever the German tongue resounds And sings songs to God in Heaven - but is humorously understood as nominative: And God in Heaven sings songs. ‡ One can think and write only when sitting down. § das Sitzfleisch: etymologically 'the posterior' (sitting-flesh). 'Assiduity', from sedere = to sit, is cognate. Hence the contrast with 'walking' ideas. * According to Plato (Phaedo), Socrates' last words were: 'Crito, I owe a cock to Asclepius; will you remember to pay the debt?' One gave a cock to Asclepius on recovering from an illness: Socrates seems to be saying that life is, or his life has been an illness. † Specifically the

followers of Schopenhauer, among whom Nietzsche himself was numbered in his young days. ‡ Unanimity of the wise. * Nietzsche's first published book. † a monster in face, a monster in soul. * from the viewpoint of eternity. * The school of Parmenides of Elea (fifth century BC), who denied the logical possibility of change and motion and argued that the only logical possibility was unchanging being. * the cause of itself. † the most real being. * The context makes it clear that this Kantian-sounding term is not being employed in the sense of Kant's twelve a priori 'categories', but simply to mean the faculty of reasoning. * the truth = Wahrheit, corresponding to wahre Welt = real world. † i.e. Kantian, from the northerly German city in which Kant was born and in which he lived and died. ‡ Here meaning empiricism, philosophy founded on observation and experiment. * Zarathustra begins. * The passions must be killed. * The abbey at Soligny from which the Trappist order – characterized by the severity of its discipline – takes its name. * Behold the man! * In Kant's philosophy the causes of sensations are called 'things in themselves'. The thing in itself is unknowable: the sensations we actually experience are produced by the operation of our subjective mental apparatus. † ugly shameful part. * first cause. * Nietzsche introduced this term in *Towards a Genealogy of Morals* I 11: it means man considered as an animal, and the first use of the term is immediately followed by a reference to 'the Roman, Arab, Teutonic, Japanese nobility, the Homeric heroes, the Scandinavian Vikings' and to the Athenians of the age of Pericles as examples of men 'the animal' in whom 'has to get out again, has to go back to the wilderness.' * The 'untouchables' excluded from the caste system. * This is one of the major themes of *The Anti-Christ*. † pious fraud. * beer. * A philosophical term meaning an explanation of something adequate to explaining it fully. Schopenhauer's doctoral thesis was *On the Fourfold Root of the Principle of Sufficient Reason*, and Nietzsche sometimes (as here) uses the term in a humorously inappropriate context. * beauty is for the few. * in natural dirtiness. † *Der Trompeter von Säckingen* (1853) by Joseph Viktor von Scheffel once enjoyed huge popularity in Germany; Viktor Nessler's opera based on it (1844) was also a popular success. ‡ oder die Schule der Geläufigkeit – nach Weibern. The joke is untranslatable: or the school of Geläufigkeit – after women. 'Geläufigkeit' means facility, skill (referring to Liszt's virtuosity as a pianist), but its root is 'laufen' = to run; and 'läufisch' means, among other things, lecherous. § milk in abundance. * scandal. † The headquarters in Paris of Jansenism, the doctrine that the human will is constitutionally incapable of goodness, and that salvation is therefore by free and undeserved grace. Sainte-Beuve wrote a celebrated history (1840–59) of the intellectual movement which grew up around PortRoyal. * *The Imitation of Christ*, a famous work attributed to the German mystic Thomas à Kempis (1379–1471). † das Ewig-Weibliche, Goethe's coinage in the last lines of *Faust* ('The eternal-feminine draws us aloft'), is often the

object of Nietzsche's mockery, apparently because he cannot see any meaning in it. * petty facts. * In *The Birth of Tragedy*. * I am my own successor. †... that worthy gentleman who, returning from an amorous rendezvous as if things had gone well, said gratefully: 'Though the power be lacking, the lust is praiseworthy.' 'Voluptas' replaces the usual 'voluntas' = will. * Refers to the last lines of Luther's hymn 'Ein feste Burg' – where, however, what is to be let depart is the things of this world and the Reich means the kingdom of Heaven. * Schön and hässlich is the German translation of Macbeth's witches' 'fair and foul'. † Fragmentary sketches by Nietzsche published after his death, i.e. long after this reference to them. * intellectual love of God. † Art for art's sake. * The opening line of Tamino's aria in Mozart's *The Magic Flute*. † children or books. ‡ I shall look at myself, I shall read myself, I shall delight myself and I shall say: Can I really have had so much wit? * oxen: to work hard, slave – also to cram, study hard. † In Goethe's *Faust*, Part I, Scene 3. ‡ The seat of the Wagner Festival. § Parsifal, eponymous hero of Wagner's last opera, is described as a pure, i.e. chaste, fool (reine Tor) whose naïvety is proof against temptation of every kind. Nietzsche considered the plot of Parsifal preposterous and persistently uses the phrase 'reine Torheit' (pure folly) in the sense of complete folly. * shameful part. * pure, raw. * Sehr verbunden! – a play on the name of the 'Bund'. * Alludes to Max von Schenkendorf's poem 'Freiheit, die ich meine' (Freedom as I mean it). * Quotation from the closing scene of *Faust*, Part Two. † It is unworthy of great spirits to spread abroad the agitation they feel. * in respect of tactics. * Refers to Goethe's *Venetian Epigrams*, in which the Cross is one of four things Goethe says he cannot endure. † i.e. the Revaluation of all Values. * more enduring than brass. * Menippus (third century BC), of the Cynic school of philosophy, produced a number of satires no longer extant. * From the title of Book VII of Goethe's novel *Wilhelm Meister's Apprenticeship*: 'Confessions of a Beautiful Soul'. † German foolishness. * For Nietzsche's theory that all events recur eternally and its emotional significance in providing the most extreme formula of life-affirmation, see *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*, Part III ('Of the Vision and the Riddle', 'The Convalescent' and 'The Seven Seals') and Part IV ('The Intoxicated Song'). * From *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*, Part III, 'Of Old and New Law-Tables', with minor variants. * In Greek mythology a race dwelling beyond the north wind (Boreas) in a country of warmth and plenty. * original sin. † A famous theological college in Swabia. * 'Act as if the maxim of your action were to become through your will a general natural law' is one of the definitions of the 'categorical imperative' in Kant's *Metaphysic of Morals*. * The highest or priestly caste in the Hindu system, † 'Charity' is in the Lutheran Bible rendered by the word 'love' ('Liebe'). * condition. * characteristic. * 'That is as fitting as a fist in the eye' is a German idiom meaning a complete unlikeness between two things – 'alike as chalk and cheese'. † Amphitryon's wife Alcmene

refused to sleep with him until he had revenged the death of her brothers; while
 Amphitryon was away engaged on this task his still virgin bride was seduced by
 Zeus and subsequently gave birth to Heracles. * Matthew vi, 28–30. * God, as
 Paul created him, is a denial of God. † ‘The Law’ in Paul’s usage of the word. *
 From a famous line in Schiller’s *Maid of Orleans*: ‘Against stupidity the gods
 themselves fight in vain.’ * To the greater honour of God. * undecisiveness. *
 ‘Fingerfertigkeit’ plays upon ‘finger of God’. * Thus Spoke Zarathustra, Part III,
 ‘Of the Priests’. * I Corinthians vii, 2 and 9. * A phrase from Goethe’s *Elective
 Affinities*. * ‘The eternal Jew’ is also the German form of the Wandering Jew. *
 In German, Nihilist und Christ do rhyme. * unlucky day.

Part X

Ecce Homo

1888 — Translated by R.J. Hollingdale

ECCE HOMO HOW ONE BECOMES WHAT ONE IS TRANSLATED
WITH NOTES BY R. J. Hollingdale INTRODUCTION BY Michael Tanner
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and Evil 82 h Genealogy of Morals 84 4 Twilight of the Idols 86 / oThe Wagner
Case 89 Why I am a Destiny 96 NOTES IO INTRODUCTION Ecce Homo is
the title of Friedrich Nietzsche's autobiography. Almost certainly it is the most
bizarre example of that genre ever penned. Its oddness begins with the title,
which is a clear reference to St John's Gospel, where it is narrated that Pilate
brought Jesus out with his crown of thorns for the Jews to see, and said to them:
'Behold the man!' So Nietzsche is evidently comparing himself to Christ, and
whether seriously or in jest, the comparison remains equally blasphemous. But
the subtitle is bewildering, and in a peculiarly Nietzschean way: one needs to

read the whole book to see what it means and then to read Nietzsche's other books to see what it really means. 'How one becomes what one is.' Immediately several questions spring to the reader's mind. For instance: how could one fail to be what one is in the first place? So how can it make sense to say that one becomes what one is? And supposing that is what happens, can Nietzsche really tell us how it comes about, as his subtitle promises? And why 'what one is'? Is it significant, as one uneasily feels it must be, that Nietzsche says 'what' rather than the more expectable 'who'? Thus in a state possibly of outrage and certainly of puzzlement, one moves on to the contents page where more surprises are waiting: the first three chapters are called 'Why I am So Wise', 'Why I am So Clever' and 'Why I Write Such Good Books'; the remainder are the titles of almost all of Nietzsche's books, except for the last chapter, 'Why I am a Destiny'. Either, one suspects, this is a joke of a rather heavy-handed 'Teutonic' variety, or Nietzsche's madness, which is usually thought to have begun pretty abruptly early in January 1889, INTRODUCTION was actually under way while he was writing this book during the autumn of 1888. Neither of these suspicions is without foundation, but there is more to it than that. Though Nietzsche had no idea that this was to be his last book, indeed was full of plans for further ones, he seems to have felt that a point had been reached in his life and his work where a retrospective celebration was in place. By this time in his writing he was more fascinated than he had ever been by the possibilities of parody, and the traditional form of autobiography must have been enormously attractive. For what are autobiographies, in general, but prolonged celebrations of the achievements of their authors? The very idea of writing one's autobiography could be said to be megalomaniac; one is assuming that one's life is either sufficiently exemplary or sufficiently idiosyncratic to be worth retailing for general consumption. The lack of explicit self-congratulation that is one of the conventions of the form is merely a device for getting readers to note how modesty, too, is a quality the author has, besides all the others that emerge from his accounts of his actions and sufferings. It isn't in the least surprising, then, that once Nietzsche had realized that the genre could so readily be adapted with mischievous intent, he should embark on it. And his mood during that whole year tended to be euphoric. It is a mistake to claim, as commentators often do, that it was an exceptionally prolific year; by Nietzsche's standards it wasn't. If one counts the titles of the books he wrote, or in two cases self-cannibalized, during 1888, the tally is indeed startling: *The Case of Wagner*, *Twilight of the Idols*, *The Antichrist*, *Dithyrambs of Dionysos*, *Nietzsche contra Wagner* and *Ecce Homo* itself. But none of them is very long, three in fact are of moderate pamphlet-length and all of them together are shorter than, say, *The Gay Science* or *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*. But they are all characterized by an intensity remarkable even for him, and usually, too {*The Antichrist* is the exception}, by almost unrestrained ebullience. Extravagant in

mode as they are, their extravagance is frequently of a parodic variety. The brevity with which Nietzsche performs only adds to the effect of laughing seriousness something that Nietzsche had very often preached, but never before succeeded in practicing so continuously and with so little sense of strain. In one of his most famous passages, 'How the "Real World" at last Became a Myth' in *Twilight of the Idols*, he manages to produce a history of Western philosophy which is both hilarious and unnervingly accurate. Nietzsche divides up the history of the concept of the 'real world' into six stages, characterizes each of them in a couple of lines and then adds a parenthesized ironic commentary on the progress of the idea. Not only that, but the whole section is integrated into his own philosophy, so that as the 'real world' disappears Zarathustra makes his debut. But marvellous as that section is, the whole ninety pages of *Twilight of the Idols* is on the highest level, an amazing condensation of his mature views, and one of the most exhilarating intellectual and literary achievements I know of. The state of inspiration which he claims, in *Ecce Homo*, to have been in whilst writing *Thus Spoke Zarathustra* is far more plausibly attributable to him, in my view, during this last year of his sane life. And by the time he began to write *Ecce Homo*, he seems to have realized that some peak had been reached. For along with the high spirits, the manic self-celebrations, the parodistic orgies, there is a tone of elegy which consorts extraordinarily well with those other tones, producing an effect of a kind that is uniquely moving, especially when one knows that total and permanent breakdown was imminent. The Foreword strikes a sombre, portentous note, of a kind familiar from many of Nietzsche's writings when he is concerned with the complete neglect that he suffered from his contemporaries, especially in his own country. The idea is given out here, and recurs as a leitmotif throughout the book, that the world is owed a reckoning by Nietzsche, since the effect he is about to have on it will be so cataclysmic that we must know what, and/or who, has hit us. While there can be no doubt that this claim of Nietzsche's is partly pathological - that in his *INTRODUCTION* he truly thought that he was about to achieve something earth-shattering - it also makes perfectly good sense insofar as the challenge that he presents us with, if we take it seriously, must radically alter our lives. And because, at this stage in his work, he identifies himself with the books he has written - or at least does that for some of the time - he feels that it is imperative that we understand him, if only so that we shall not confuse him with other life-changers who want us to know what they are like so that we can be like that too. Hence the cardinal significance of the closing words of the Foreword, quoted from *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*: 'You had not yet sought yourselves when you found me. Thus do all believers; therefore all belief is of so little account. Now I bid you love me and find yourselves; and only when you have all denied me will I return to you.' This is perhaps Nietzsche's most

succinct statement of his revulsion »i the idea of living one's life by modelling it on what someone else said or did. One becomes what one is by not being anyone else - something that is in any case impossible, but that has not deterred most people, including all admirers of Thomas a Kempis's *Imitation of Christ*, a book for which Nietzsche felt especial distaste, from making the attempt. If we take this as the major theme of *Ecce Homo*, a lot that seems absurd, exaggerated or merely false becomes, at the very least, highly interesting. For the book becomes an attempt to demonstrate, in a variety of more or less shocking ways, how Nietzsche contrived to achieve an independence of spirit in the face of a series of strong temptation * to capitulate to powerful influences. Above all it tries to show how he practised a kind of systematic ingratitude towards those great figures who meant most to him, and how this is the only way of taking them completely seriously - whereas the usual view is that to take someone seriously is to allow them to dominate one to a degree that involves abandoning oneself, if only for a time. What commands admiration even in the shrillest passages of *Ecce Homo*, as in the other late works, is the candour with which Nietzsche exposes his own failings in this respect, while still INTRODUCTION turning them to positive account. How, in other words, does one turn discipleship into apostasy, while not betraying what one has been? As he puts it in the profound words of section 6 of the chapter on Thus Spoke Zarathustra, 'The psychological problem in the type of Zarathustra is how he, who to an unheard-of degree says No, does No to everything to which one has hitherto said Yes, can none the less be the opposite of a spirit of denial.' It isn't surprising that he doesn't give a straightforward answer to that question, but proceeds by considering the major figures in his development, figures who are, as always, personifications of attitudes to life which Nietzsche-Zarathustra (the predominance of Zarathustra in the book is partly the result of a degree of identification which Nietzsche had not previously allowed himself) has to take with all the seriousness due to his most dangerous opponents. Schopenhauer, Richard Wagner, Socrates, Christ make their final appearances - though the manner in which they do so shows that, if Nietzsche had continued to write, he would still have been preoccupied with them, since at least in the case of the last three, their seductiveness is something that one can never safely say one has conclusively overcome. It is Richard Wagner to whom Nietzsche most obsessively returns in *Ecce Homo*, no doubt because he is the only major figure in Nietzsche's demonology with whom he had had a personal relationship, and one which Nietzsche was never inclined to devalue. The most lyrical passages of the book are expressions of what the relationship had meant, and therefore are all the more poignant because it had been essential to his spiritual well-being to terminate it. Section 5 of 'Why I am So Clever' is the most compressed statement in Nietzsche's work of the complexity of his feelings about Wagner: I offer all my other human relationships cheap; but at no price would I

relinquish from my life the Tribschen days, those days of mutual confidences, of cheerfulness, of sublime xi INTRODUCTION incidents - of profound moments... I do not know what others may have experienced with Wagner: over our sky no cloud ever passed. An idealization, no doubt, but it would be a steely soul who queried it. It makes all the more dramatic, of course, the rest of the section, where Wagner is shown to have become what he was not, and therefore to be the antipode of Nietzsche - though that is not how he puts it here; but that '[Wagner] became reichsdeutsch' is what Nietzsche says he couldn't forgive him. In other words, in this account, Wagner capitulated to the cultural pressures of the newly unified Germany, in all its loutish vulgarity, and allowed himself to be cast as its arch- representative in the arts. But the dialectic of Wagner's inverted progress, and thus of Nietzsche's relationship to him, is more complicated than that. For the delicatessen which he is supposed to have renounced was a Parisian affair and thus already a matter of decadence, so that even before he became corrupted by the Reich, Wagner was of the tribe of Berlioz and Delacroix, who had 'a fond of sickness, of incurability in their nature, sheer fanatics for expression, virtuosi through and through.. .' Decadence is, of course, one of the key terms in Nietzsche's later vocabulary, but the complexity of his feelings towards it is apparent both here, where he accuses Wagner of treachery towards it, and in the next section of the chapter, where he produces his most abandoned eulogy of Wagner the artist, in his ecstatic celebration of *Tristan und Isolde*: I still today seek a work of a dangerous fascination, of a sweet and shuddery infinity equal to that of *Tristan* - I seek in all the arts in vain. All the strangenesses of Leonardo da Vinci lose their magic at the first note of *Tristan*.. . The world is poor for him who has never been sick enough for this 'voluptuousness of hell'. XII INTRODUCTION And more to the same effect. Now, in a spectacular and altogether characteristic move, Nietzsche claims that it is the very dangerousness of *Tristan*, and the fact that he is able to incorporate it without being corrupted by it, that makes Wagner 'the great benefactor of my life'. Having one's cake and eating it could go no further. What is still more remarkable is that, in this context, the feat is justified. Nietzsche is here demonstrating how he was able to take something with a seriousness which is simply beyond the grasp of most people, and yet still not take it ultimately seriously, and so giving us a purchase on his much self- celebrated 'lightness', which elsewhere in his work can seem a sadly laboured affair. It is the high point in his work of that capacity for simultaneous celebration and critique which should exhilarate us as much as it obviously did him. And it is also the place where we can hope to grasp how the man who was so constant an exhorter to 'self-overcoming' should also have been the man who incited us to 'become ourselves'. At Nietzsche's greatest moments he achieves an ecstasy which one would not have thought possible outside the context of a transcendental ideal in

process of realization: the self, which we normally take as a given with which we have to live, making adjustments and modifications within fairly depressing limits, is revealed as something - or rather, less than something - capable of enormous expansion and transformation through the absorption of experiences which mostly we attempt to suppress or deny. And even worse than suppression and denial is regret. At this final stage of his life as a writer Nietzsche is so intent on regretting nothing that he moves to the opposite pole - but as he has so frequently reminded us in his later works, the 'faith in opposite values' is largely chimerical, so that we find, to our initial puzzlement, that there is a strong if not a pervasive tone of nostalgia, or something very like it, in these very last works. If it were nostalgia as we ordinarily think of it, Nietzsche would be performing a sleight of hand; for that kind of nostalgia is regret that the past is past. People are usually xiii INTRODUCTION obsessed with the past, and in particular with their past, either because they wish it had been different or because they can't believe that things will ever again be so good. Nietzsche's concern with the past is a matter of delighting in its having been as it was, whatever that may have been, because it enables him to make the present so much better. Critical as he always was of the concept of redemption, he still writes in section 8 of the chapter on Thus Spoke Zarathustra: 'On one occasion Zarathustra strictly defines his task - it is also mine - the meaning of which cannot be misunderstood: he is affirmative to the point of justifying, of redeeming even the entire past.' And he goes on to quote one of the most celebrated but bewildering passages from that book, which concludes 'To redeem the past and to transform every "It was" into an "I wanted it thus!" - that alone would I call redemption.' For a long time I felt that that last exhortation of Zarathustra was only inspiring so long as one didn't enquire too carefully what it meant. For clearly the past cannot be changed and redemption would seem to require that. But what can be changed is our way of looking at it, of evaluating it. Even then, a great deal of anyone's life might seem irredeemable, in that it was time wasted, or put to futile or bad purposes. In other words, to eliminate the concept of regret from our outlook, to purge ourselves of nostalgia and remorse, demands a transformation of consciousness which we can hardly give sense to. But that is precisely Nietzsche-Zarathustra's point. The change he demands is one which, in depriving us of our humanity, would enable us to become superhuman. And 'there has never yet been a superman', Nietzsche tells us. Could there be, if this is the condition for its fulfilment? He is not concerned, in *Ecce Homo*, to answer that question. But what he does make vividly clear is the hopeless rut that we are all in if it can't be answered affirmatively. It would be giving a grievously false impression of *Ecce Homo* to suggest that it is all on this solemn and imposing level. All xiv INTRODUCTION told, it is Nietzsche's most mischievous hook, in which along with self-celebrations which have led many readers to assume that he was already mad, there is an enormous amount of

mockery, not least of the author. Often it isn't possible to say where mockery takes over; it is part of Nietzsche's 'most manifold art of style' that one is unsure which style he is practising. But at the same time another of the pairs of 'opposite values' that he routs in this book is that of seriousness and joking. For instance, there is no doubt that he means what he says in his stress on 'the little things' as being of an importance that philosophers have never granted them - climate, diet, digestion, when to read and so on. 'The whole casuistry of selfishness -... beyond all conception of greater importance than anything that has been considered of importance hitherto. It is precisely here that one has to begin to learn anew.' And he stresses that the organ he uses to come to his most important conclusions is his nose. 'I was the first to discover the truth, in that I was the first to sense - smell - the lie as lie. My genius is in my nostrils' ('Why I am a Destiny', i). This passage follows almost immediately on his writing: I have a terrible fear I shall one day be pronounced holy: one will guess why I bring out this book beforehand; it is intended to prevent people from making mischief with me I do not want to be a saint, rather even a buffoon. Perhaps I am a buffoon... and none the less, or rather not none the less - for there has hitherto been nothing more mendacious than saints - the truth speaks out of me. Yet in the next section he writes: I am by far the most terrible human being there has ever been; this does not mean I shall not be the most beneficent. His terrible fear that he would one day be pronounced holy came to pass at his funeral, when his friend, the composer Peter xv INTRODUCTION Gast, said: 'May your name be holy to future generations' - a friend whom he praises extravagantly in the pages of *Ecce Homo*. The desperate jocularity of the book is justified; yet if it had been composed in uniformly serious tones it would have been no less misunderstood; no one knew better than Nietzsche that there is no insurance against stupidity. Therefore, it might be felt, he courted misunderstanding; the book has autobiographical passages which are easy to check up on and determine that they are false. It presents his life as if there had been a plan in it, which there evidently wasn't, and it alternates between the world-historical and the mundane in a way that was bound to offend its readers' taste, as it still does. But, Nietzsche would say, and almost does, so much the worse for their taste. And it is in fact the very notion of taste, allied to that of smelling, which Nietzsche makes greatest and most inspired play with. In celebrating his capacity for locating decadence, for castigating the Germans for their deep-seated vulgarity, for revelling in destruction as a prerequisite of creation, for knowing what has to be created, Nietzsche is relying throughout on his extraordinarily developed sensitivity to phenomena which none of his contemporaries was able to notice, partly because they knew too much and esteemed the wrong kind of knowing. That is why he advertises his ignorance, his long-time refusal to read, which had earned him ostracism from the cultural community - the community of the 'philistines of

culture', bogged down in their specializations, 'sick with this inhuman clockwork and mechanism, with the loss of personality of the worker, with the false economy of "division of labour". The goal gets lost, culture - the means, the modern way of carrying on science, barbarized' A great deal of *Ecce Homo* makes fun of the ghastliness of contemporary life, though time and again Nietzsche's almost boundless capacity for humour is overtaken by impatience at his fate in being ignored, and he is driven back to quoting Thus Spoke Zarathustra at its most portentous, even though 'to have understood, that is to say experienced, six sentences of that book would raise one to a higher level of mortals that "modern" man xvi [INTRODUCTION could attain to' ('Why I Write Such Good Books', i). It is passages like that, and not the exuberantly auto-eulogistic ones, which are the most painful in the book. The tragedy of his life was that there were no means available to change people's taste, and without that he was bound to fail in his heroic endeavour, which lasted as long as he remained sane, and even for a few days after that, to make his contemporaries realize their plight. 'My time has not yet come, some are born posthumously,' he writes in the same paragraph as the previous quotation. And it is immediately followed by 'how could I, with this feeling of distance, even want the "modern men" I know - to read me!' but of course, that is what he did want, for their sake rather than his. If he could return now, he would find that 'modern men' are still what they were. They have still not understood that 'I have the right to understand myself as the first tragic philosopher - that is to say the extremest antithesis and antipodes of a pessimistic philosopher' ('The Birth of Tragedy', 3). And in answer to the final words of the book: '- Have I been understood? - Dionysos against the Crucified.' the answer must be a resounding 'No'. Cambridge, April 1991 Michael Tanner

NOTE ON THE TEXT This edition is annotated only lightly: its intention is to offer the reader a clean, unobstructed text. Nietzsche wrote *Ecce Homo* between 15 October and 4 November 1888 - that is to say, in just under three weeks - but continued to make alterations and additions. In a letter to Overbeck dated 13 November 1888 he says that 'the manuscript of *Ecce Homo*. How One Becomes What One Is is already with the printer'; subsequently he asked the printer (Naumann, Leipzig) for the return of the 'second part of the manuscript' and then of the whole manuscript: it was sent back to him, but he kept it only two or three days and returned it to Naumann on 6 December. Naumann must have started setting the book at once, since by the date of his breakdown Nietzsche had corrected the proofs of the title-page, the list of contents, the Foreword, 'On this perfect day..', the first chapter and the second chapter up to the words 'Caution, even hostility towards new books is rather part of my instinct than "tolerance", "largeur du coeur" and other forms of "neighbour love"..' in section 3. Up to this point no question as to the validity of the text published in 1908 can arise, since the author passed it for publication: it is over the remainder of the

text that controversy has arisen. It was started by Erich Podach - a very experienced Nietzsche-scholar to whom a Nietzsche-biographer is in debt - with the publication in 1961 of his *Friedrich Nietts(sches Werke des Zusammenbruchs*, a printing of manuscript versions of Nietzsche's last works with extensive editorial comment. The item in which Podach's edition departs most widely from the accepted version is *Ecce Homo*, which Podach claims never achieved a final, completed form in xvni NOTE on THE TEXT Nietzsche's hands, the accepted version being a redaction by Peter Gast: he then prints a version of *Ecce Homo* which includes variant passages, superseded drafts and repetitions. The violence of the criticism Erich Podach brought down upon himself for this edition was due, not to the publication of these variants in itself, but to the unpleasing acerbity of his own criticism of other editors and scholars and to his claim to have produced the only valid editions of the final works, a claim which was at once contested. The details of the controversy which ensued are too voluminous to be included here: its outcome, however, was in my judgement the vindication of the validity of *Ecce Homo* in its accepted form, with the proviso that some passages may have been suppressed (i.e. destroyed) and some repetitions eliminated when the original edition of 1908 was prepared. The strongest evidence that a final form was achieved by Nietzsche seems to me to be the fact that C. G. Naumann began setting the book in type - a thing he would hardly have done if he had not had a completed and legible MS before him. (The interested reader is referred for details of the controversy over Podach's edition firstly, of course, to the *Werke des Zusammenbruchs* itself, then to Walter Kaufmann's essay 'Nietzsche in the Light of his Suppressed Manuscripts', reprinted in the third edition of his *Nietzsche*; to Kaufmann's summary in the 'Note on the Publication of *Ecce Homo*' prefaced to his edition of *Ecce Homo*, in which he also translates and comments on variants from Nietzsche's drafts for the book; and to the 'Philologische Nachbericht' to Karl Schlechta's edition of Nietzsche's *Werke* and the 'Erganzung' in the index volume to that edition.)

R. J. H. CHRONOLOGY OF NIETZSCHE'S LIFE 1844 Friedrich Wilhelm Nietzsche born (15 October) in the parsonage at Rocken, near Liitzen, Prussian Saxony. His father, Karl Ludwig Nietzsche (b. 1813, the same year as Wagner), is the village pastor and the son of a pastor; his mother, Franziska Nietzsche (b. Oehler in 1826, and thus only eighteen years old), is the daughter of the pastor of the nearby village of Pobles. Friedrich Wilhelm - named after the reigning king of Prussia - is the first child of their marriage. They have two further children: Elizabeth (b. 10 July 1846) and Josef (b. February 1848, d. January 1850). 1849 Pastor Nietzsche dies (27 July): cause of death is given as 'softening of the brain' (encephalomalacia) following a fall. 1850 The family - now consisting of Nietzsche, his paternal grandmother, his mother, his sister and two maiden aunts - has to leave the parsonage and removes (April) to Naumburg, in Thuringia,

where Nietzsche enters the town boys' school. In 1851 he transfers to a private preparatory school. 1854 He attends the high school (Domgymnasium), where he comes to be considered a gifted pupil. His surviving juvenilia confirm this judgement, although there is nothing to indicate precocious originality. During the summer of 1856 he is released from school because of persistent headaches and eye-trouble. 1858 The family moves to No. 18 Weingarten, subsequently the first 'Nietzsche Archive'. Nietzsche wins a free place (CHRONOLOGY 01 m i r/sc.n I S i i I E at Schulpforta, the Prussian Rugby, and starts there on 5 October. At first he finds the discipline hard and suffers from homesickness: later, when he has discovered he has no difficulty in mastering the classical studies upon which the emphasis of the curriculum is laid and as a consequence comes to be regarded as an outstanding scholar, he enjoys being at Schulpforta. His attainments in other studies are, however, not remarkable. (The examining board are supposed on this account to have been on the point of refusing him the equivalent of a school-leaving certificate when one of them, presumably a classicist, exclaimed: 'But, meine Herren, are we really going to fail the best pupil Pforta has ever had?!') 1860 With two Naumburg friends, Wilhelm Pinder and Gustav Krug, he forms (25 July) a literary society, 'Germania', and for the following three years tries out essays, poems and compositions on the society. In March 1861 Krug lectures on Tristan und Isolde, and Nietzsche first hears Wagner. But his favourite composer throughout the Pforta years continues to be Schumann (d. 1856, but none the less a contemporary, 'modern' composer: the as yet unperformed Tristan is still the music of the future). 1864 He leaves Pforta (4 September) and enters Bonn University (16 October) as a student of theology and philology; in the latter subject he is a pupil of Friedrich Ritschl, whom he subsequently follows to Leipzig. 1865 Paul Deussen tells us (*Erinnerungen an Friedrich Nietzsche*) that Nietzsche tells him he has visited Cologne (February), where he has been taken to a brothel against his will, though he left again at once. As Nietzsche subsequently suffered from and eventually succumbed to syphilis, it seems probable that he does not leave at once or that he later returns. During 1867 he is treated by two Leipzig doctors for a syphilitic infection. (On Nietzsche's 'illness', and whether it was or was not syphilis: 1. As Nietzsche was a university student in the Germany of the 1860s to CHRONOLOGY OF NIETZSCHE'S LIFE 1870s it would have been rather remarkable if he had not visited a brothel at least once. H. W. Brann, in his scholarly and entertaining study of Nietzsche's erotic life, *Nietzsche und die Frauen*, interprets the long poem which forms the staple of the chapter 'Among the Daughters of the Desert' in the fourth part of Zarathustra as a barely disguised recollection of a visit to a brothel - an interpretation which does not seem at all farfetched and originated in Brann's noticing similarities between its phraseology and that of Deussen's account mentioned above. [The poem, 'Die Wiiste wachst', was also included by

Nietzsche in the collection *Dionysos-Dithyramben*: that it is one of his worst does not affect its evidential value.] 2. The course of his illness from the first incapacitations in 1871 to total collapse at the beginning of 1889 is entirely typical of the disease in question - the only atypical aspect being the length of time between collapse and death [eleven years]. 3. As many passages in his writings, and especially some in the uninhibited *Ecce Homo*, disclose, Nietzsche was highly sexed, yet there is no record, or even hint, that he ever went to bed with a woman of his own class and, the documentation of his life being as ample as it is, we may conclude that he never did so. He had many women friends but not one wife or mistress. The reason may, as has very generally been assumed, be that he suffered from paralysing inhibition: but might this inhibition, if it really existed, not have originated in his knowledge that he suffered from something else too? something that, seeing he was a man of honour, must for ever keep him 'celibate' in relation to women of his own class? There are only two known occasions, recorded below, on which pressure of feeling overbore this restraint. [Richard Wagner believed he had discovered the cause of the young Nietzsche's frequent headaches and prostrations to lie in 'excessive masturbation', which diagnosis he communicated by letter to Nietzsche's doctor, Otto Eiser, of xxii

CHRONOLOGY OF NIETZSCHE'S LIFE Frankfurt: when he learned what Wagner had done, Nietzsche flew into a rage and declared he would never forgive what he termed 'this interference'.)] At Easter 1865 he abandons the study of theology (as a consequence of a loss of Christian belief) and on 17 August he leaves Bonn for Leipzig. At the end of October or beginning of November he buys a copy of Schopenhauer's *The World as Will and Idea* from a second-hand bookshop on an impulse, the book being then unknown to him: soon afterwards he announces to his friends that he has become a 'Schopenhauerian'. 1 866 Nietzsche's work on *Theognis* convinces Ritschl Nietzsche is the most advanced pupil for his age he has ever taught and, on 24 February, he tells him so: thereafter Nietzsche is Ritschl's protege, In the summer he reads F. A. Lange's *History of Materialism*. Beginning of his friendship with Erwin Rohde. 1 867 Nietzsche's first publication: 'Zur Geschichte der Theognideischen Spruchsammlung' in the *Rheinische Museum für Philologie*. He is conscripted for a year's military service in the mounted section of a field artillery regiment (9 October-15 October 1868). 1 868 'De Laertii Diogenis fontibus' and other philological studies published in the *Rheinische Museum und Litterarisches Centralblatt* (also 1869). He is 'converted' to Wagner after a performance of the *Tristan and Meistersinger* preludes (28 October), and meets him for the first time eleven days later at the house of Wagner's brother-in-law Hermann Brockhaus: he learns that Wagner is also an admirer of Schopenhauer, and Wagner and Schopenhauer now combine to become what is emotionally Nietzsche's new religion. 1869 Nietzsche is appointed to the chair of classical philology at Basel

and as teacher of Greek at the associated grammar school (13 February) at the age of twenty-four: he owes the appointment to Ritschl's recommendation. He is awarded his doctorate by Leipzig (23 March) without examination. At the request of Basel he applies to be relieved of his military obligations (i.e. to cease to be a citizen of Prussia) and for Swiss citizenship: the former application is granted; the latter is not, as he lacks the necessary residential qualification. (Nietzsche fails to renew this application and is consequently for the rest of his life stateless.) He arrives in Basel on 19 April. He visits Wagner at Tribschen, near Lucerne, on 15 May, is unable to see him and returns on 17 May; he is invited to attend Wagner's birthday celebrations on 22 May, but his teaching duties make this impossible. He pays his next visit for the weekend 5 to 7 June, and is thereafter a regular visitor: he stays with the Wagner family twenty-three times in the three years to April 1872, when Wagner leaves Tribschen for Bayreuth. Inaugural lecture on 'Homer and Classical Philology' delivered 28 May. He meets Jakob Burckhardt (b. 1818), the historian, and Franz Overbeck (b. 1837), the theologian. He spends Christmas with Wagner. 1870 Public lectures on 'The Greek Music-Drama' (18 January) and 'Socrates and Tragedy' (1 February). He obtains leave to serve as a medical orderly with the Prussian army (11 August): he collapses with dysentery and diphtheria (7 September) after tending casualties at Erlangen for three days and nights continuously. He returns to Basel at the end of October, and spends Christmas with Wagner, when he is present at the first performance of the *Siegfried Idyll* in the front hall at Tribschen. 1871 Nietzsche applies unsuccessfully for the chair of philosophy at Basel (January). He now begins to suffer from regularly recurring periods of exhaustion, and henceforward is never really well. On 15 February he is granted leave of absence 'for the purpose of restoring his health': he visits Lugano, the Bernese Oberland, Naumburg and Leipzig, and works on *The Birth of Tragedy*. He returns to Basel at the end of the year. 1872 *The Birth of Tragedy* published January. Public lectures 'On the Future of our Educational Institutions' (16 January, 6 and 27 February, 5 and 23 March). He attends the laying of the foundation stone of the Festival Theatre at Bayreuth (22 May). Meeting with Paul Ree. 1873 *Untimely Meditations I: David Strauss* published. 1874 *Untimely Meditations II: On the Use and Disadvantage of History*, and *III: Schopenhauer as Educator* published. During this year Nietzsche first becomes fully conscious of a previously unconscious dissatisfaction with and rebellion against Wagner-Schopenhauer, and thus begins consciously to resist and deny this dissatisfaction: the outcome is a state of internal tension which leads to such incidents as the violent scene between him and Wagner on the occasion of what was to prove his last private visit (August). After this visit he does not see Wagner again for nearly two years. 1875 Meeting with Peter Gast, afterwards his

earliest 'disciple'. Violent headaches and vomiting attacks in June mean he cannot visit Bayreuth as intended: he goes for a 'cure' to Steinabad, in the Black Forest, and at once begins to feel much better. Elizabeth moves to Basel and sets up home for herself and her brother. Nietzsche suffers a general collapse at Christmas. 1876 He is granted a long period of absence from Basel because of his persistent ill-health. At Geneva he proposes marriage to one Mathilde Trampedach, and is rejected. In mid-April he returns to Basel. Untimely Meditations IV: Richard Wagner in Bayreuth published July. On 24 July he arrives in Bayreuth for the first festival, attends rehearsals, but is forced by the state of his head and eyes to leave before the festival proper begins: he goes to Klingenbrunn, in the Bavarian Forest, where he spends much of his time writing psychological reflections which will later be incorporated into *Human, All Too Human*. After ten days Elizabeth writes asking him to return to Bayreuth, CHRONOLOGY OF NIETZSCHE'S LIFE which he does on 12 August and attends the first public cycle of *The Nibelung's Ring* (13, 14, 16 and 17 August). He avoids Wagner, fails to attend the second cycle, and on 27 August returns to Basel. The university grants him sick leave for a year (15 October): he has already left for Bex, Canton Waadt, and on 20 October he goes with Ree and the novelist Albert Brenner to Sorrento, where they stay with Malwida von Meysenburg at a villa she has rented on the coast with a view across the sea to Naples and Vesuvius. All three work on books, Ree on *The Origin of the Moral Sensations*, Nietzsche on *Human, All Too Human*. Wagner is also in Sorrento, and he and Nietzsche meet for the last time. 1877 He leaves Sorrento in May, travels alone in Italy and Switzerland, arrives back in Basel in the autumn: he sets up house again with Elizabeth, Gast making a third (1 September), and resumes teaching. 1878 *Human, All Too Human* published May. In June Elizabeth goes back to Naumburg. Wagner lets it be known he regards *Human* as evidence its author has suffered a mental breakdown: 'I have done him the kindness ... of not reading his book, and my greatest wish and hope is that one day he will thank me for this.' Other acquaintances were also estranged by the new book. 1879 *Assorted Opinions and Maxims* ('first supplement' to *Human, All Too Human*) published in February. In April Nietzsche suffers the worst and most protracted attack of migraine and sickness he has yet experienced: Overbeck wires Elizabeth, who comes to Basel and finds Nietzsche apparently on the point of death. On 2 May he petitions the university for release from all duties: on 14 June he is retired on a pension. He travels with Elizabeth to Schloss Bremgarten, near Bern, then to Zurich, then alone to St Moritz: there he completes *The Wanderer and his Shadow* ('second supplement' to *Human, All Too Human*) in September. In October he goes to Naumburg. He suffers severe attacks on 118 days of this year. xxvi CHRONOLOGY OF NIETZSCHE'S LIFE! 1880 *Tbi Wanderer and his Shadow* published, *Daybreak* written. Nietzsche

to Riva (February), where he is joined by (i to Gast's home in Venice (March); to Marienbad (June); back to Naumburg (September); then south again to Basel, Stresa, Genoa, where he spends the winter. His attitude towards his invalid condition is 'philosophical': 'The daily battle against headache and the laughable diversity of my ailments demands such an amount of attention that I am running into the danger of becoming petty - but this is a counterweight to those very . high- flying tendencies that have such power over me that without some counterweight to them I would become a fool.' 1 88 1 Daybreak published in June, The Gay Science begun. Nietz- sche to Recoaro and Riva with Gast (April), and alone to St Moritz (June). Later in June to Sils-Maria - 'I know of nothing more suited to my nature than this piece of high land' - and takes up lodgings in a room attached to the house of the Biirgermeister. Back to Genoa in October. In November he sees Carmen for the first time and adopts it as the model antithesis to Wagner. 1882 The Gay Science completed in July and published in the autumn. Paul Ree with Nietzsche in Genoa (February), leaves for Rome in March, where at Malwida's house he meets Lou Salome and proposes marriage to her. Nietz- sche goes to Messina (end of March), then to Rome (end of April), where Ree introduces him to Lou. Two days afterwards Ree tells Lou Nietzsche has asked him to propose to her on his behalf. Lou declines to marry either man, and counterproposes a platonic menage-a- trois: both, faute de mieux, agree. They all spend much time together, and are photographed in a photographer's mock-up of a cart, with Nietzsche and Ree between the shafts and Fraulein Salome driving: Frl. Salome is jocularly flourish- ing a whip. Lou Salome, twenty-one, is the least strait- laced and most entertaining woman Nietzsche has yet xxvii CHRONOLOGY OF NIETZSCHE S LIFE met; also the most intelligent; and he falls in love with her. At Lucerne in May he proposes to her in person and is again rejected: Lou is a new-style liberated woman dedicated to independence. But the menage-a-trois is still on, Vienna being the proposed venue. All this is kept secret from his mother and sister, as they would have considered it extremely immoral. Nietzsche, Lou and Elizabeth at Tautenburg (Thuringia) during August: Eliza- beth becomes acquainted with the immoral plan and on the day Lou leaves (26 August) there is a scene between brother and sister. Nietzsche to Naumburg: Elizabeth writes to their mother telling her what is going on, and there is a scene between mother and son. Nietzsche to Leipzig: three weeks with Lou and Ree, who leave with- out arranging to meet him again; during the following month (November) it is borne in upon him that he has been abandoned. Nietzsche to Basel, to Genoa, to Ra- pallo: he is frantic with disappointment and self-con- tempt, and emotionally and physically almost exhausted. 1883 Thus Spoke Zarathustra, Part One, written in January- February: Nietzsche recovers his equilibrium by means of it. Wagner dies in Venice 1 3 February. Reconciliation with Elizabeth. Nietzsche to Genoa and Rome (May-

June), to Sils-Maria (June), where he writes Zarathustra, Part Two. Both parts published. In September he returns to Naumburg, and learns Elizabeth is engaged to marry Bernhard Forster, a prominent anti-Semite. In October to Genoa, in November to Nice. 1884 Zarathustra, Part Three, written during January and published later in the year. Preparation of The Will to Power begun. Nietzsche to Venice (April) and Sils-Maria (July); in October to Zurich (meeting with Gottfried Keller), then back to Nice. 1885 Zarathustra, Part Four, written and privately printed. Nietzsche to Venice (April) and Sils-Maria (June). Elizabeth and Forster marry (22 May, the late Wagner's birthday), xxviii CHRONOLOGY OF NIETZSCHE'S LIFE and leave for the colony of New Germania, in Paraguay. Nietzsche to Naumburg (September), then back to Nice (November). 1886 Beyond Good and Evil written and published. Nietzsche to Naumburg (May): last meeting with Rohde, in Leipzig. Back to Sils-Maria (July), then to Genoa (September) and Nice (October). Prefaces for new editions of his earlier works (and 1887). 1887 On the Genealogy of Morals written and published. Nietzsche to Sils-Maria (June), Venice (September), back to Nice (October). 1888 The Wagner Case written and published; The Will to Power abandoned, the Revaluation of All Values substituted, Twilight of the Idols written and prepared for publication; The Anti-Christ and Ecce Homo written; Nietzsche contra Wagner and the Dithyrambs of Dionysos assembled. Nietzsche to Turin (April), Sils-Maria (June), back to Turin (September). On 1 January the Bern Bund carries the first published review of his work as a whole (by Karl Spitteler); in April Georg Brandes lectures on his philosophy at Copenhagen. He experiences a delusive improvement in his health, and in the last quarter of the year is the victim of a morbid euphoria which is the immediate prelude to complete collapse. 1889 The Revaluation of All Values abandoned. Nietzsche collapses in the piazza Carlo Alberto, Turin (3 January): when he recovers consciousness he is no longer sane. He sends brief letters to friends, acquaintances and public figures announcing his arrival as 'Dionysos' or 'the Crucified'. Overbeck comes to Turin and takes Nietzsche to the university clinic at Basel (10 January). Diagnosis: 'paralysis progressiva'. On 17 January he is transferred to the university clinic at Jena. Twilight of the Idols published end of January, Nietzsche contra Wagner privately printed. Forster commits suicide in Paraguay (June) from fear of prosecution for frauds in connection with his colonial enterprise. xxix CHRONOLOGY OF NIETZSCHE'S LIFE 1890 Nietzsche's mother takes him back with her to No. 18 Weingarten, Naumburg, where he enters into her sole care. 1892 A collected edition of Nietzsche's published works and a selection from his notebooks is planned, with Gast as editor. 1893 Elizabeth returns from Paraguay, and Gast's edition is (1894) abandoned at her insistence ('who appointed you editor, then?'); she inaugurates a second collected edition, which is also subsequently abandoned because of disagreements over editorial

methods. In February (1894) she founds the 'Nietzsche Archive' at No. 18 Weingarten. 1895 The Anti-Christ and Nietzsche contra Wagner published. Elizabeth becomes the owner of Nietzsche's copyright. Nietzsche, mentally a child, begins to become paralysed. 1896 Elizabeth moves the 'Archive' to Weimar. 1897 Nietzsche's mother dies (20 April): Elizabeth transfers him to Weimar and lodges him and the Archive in the Villa Silberblick. 1899 A third collected edition begun. 1900 Nietzsche dies in Weimar (25 August).

ECCEHOMO HOW ONE BECOMES WHAT ONE IS FOREWORD Seeing that I must shortly approach mankind with the heaviest demand that has ever been made on it, it seems to me indispensable to say who I am. This ought really to be known already: for I have not neglected to 'bear witness' about myself. But the disparity between the greatness of my task and the smallness of my contemporaries has found expression in the fact that I have been neither heard nor even so much as seen. I live on my own credit, it is perhaps merely a prejudice that I am alive at all?... I need only to talk with any of the 'cultured people' who come to the Ober-Engadin in the summer to convince myself that I am not alive.. . Under these circumstances there exists a duty against which my habit, even more the pride of my instincts revolts, namely to say: Listen to me! for I am thus and thus. Do not, above all, confound me with what I am not! I am, for example, absolutely not a bogey-man, not a moral-monster - I am even an antithetical nature to the species of man hitherto honoured as virtuous. Between ourselves, it seems to me that precisely this constitutes part of my pride. I am a disciple of the philosopher Dionysos, I prefer to be even a satyr rather than a saint. But you have only to read this writing. Perhaps I have succeeded in giving expression to this antithesis in a cheerful and affable way - perhaps this writing had no point at all other than to do this. The last thing I would promise would be to 'improve' mankind. I erect no new idols; 3 ECCE HOMO let the old idols learn what it means to have legs of clay. To overthrow idols (my word for 'ideals') - that rather is my business. Reality has been deprived of its value, its meaning, its veracity to the same degree as an ideal world has been fabricated . The 'real world' and the 'apparent world' - in plain terms: the fabricated world and reality.. . The lie of the ideal has hitherto been the curse on reality, through it mankind itself has become mendacious and false down to its deepest instincts - to the point of worshipping the inverse values to those which alone could guarantee it prosperity, future, the exalted right to a future. 3 - He who knows how to breathe the air of my writings knows that it is an air of the heights, a robust air. One has to be made for it, otherwise there is no small danger one will catch cold. The ice is near, the solitude is terrible - but how peacefully all things lie in the light! how freely one breathes! how much one feels beneath one! - Philosophy, as I have hitherto understood and lived it, is a voluntary living in ice and high mountains - a seeking after everything strange and questionable in

existence, all that has hitherto been excommunicated by morality. From the lengthy experience afforded by such a wandering in the forbidden I learned to view the origin of moralizing and idealizing very differently from what might be desirable: the hidden history of the philosophers, the psychology of their great names came to light for me. - How much truth can a spirit bear, how much truth can a spirit dare} that became for me more and more the real measure of value. Error (- belief in the ideal -) is not blindness, error is cowardice.. . Every acquisition, every step forward in knowledge is the result of courage, of severity towards oneself, of cleanliness with respect to oneself ... I do not refute ideals, I merely draw on gloves in their presence.. . Nitimur in vetitum: in this sign my philosophy will one day conquer, for what has hitherto been forbidden on principle has never been anything but the truth. - J OKI. WOK I) - Within my writings my Zarathustra stands by itself. I have with this book given mankind the greatest gift that has ever been given it. With a voice that speaks across millennia, it is not only the most exalted book that exists, the actual book of the air of the heights - the entire fact man lies at a tremendous distance beneath it - it is also the profoundest, born out of the innermost abundance of truth, an inexhaustible well into which no bucket descends without coming up filled with gold and goodness. Here there speaks no 'prophet', none of those gruesome hybrids of sickness and will to power called founders of religions. One has above all to hear correctly the tone that proceeds from this mouth, this halcyon tone, if one is not to do pitiable injustice to the meaning of its wisdom. 'It is the stillest words which bring the storm, thoughts that come on doves' feet guide the world -' The figs are falling from the trees, they are fine and sweet: and as they fall their red skins split. I am a north wind to ripe figs. Thus, like figs, do these teachings fall to you, my friends: now drink their juice and eat their sweet flesh! It is autumn all around and clear sky and afternoon - Here there speaks no fanatic, here there is no 'preaching', here faith is not demanded: out of an infinite abundance of light and depth of happiness there falls drop after drop, word after word - a tender slowness of pace is the tempo of these discourses. Such things as this reach only the most select; it is an incomparable privilege to be a listener here; no one is free to have ears for Zarathustra.. . With all this, is Zarathustra not a seducer}... . But what does he himself say when for the first time he again goes back into his solitude? Precisely the opposite of that which any sort of 'sage', 'saint', 'world-redeemer' and other decadent would say in such a case . He does not only speak differently, he is different... 5 ECCE HOMO I now go away alone, my disciples! You too now go away and be alone! So I will have it. Go away from me and guard yourselves against Zarathustra! And better still: be ashamed of him! Perhaps he has deceived you. The man of knowledge must be able not only to love his enemies but also to hate his friends. One repays a teacher badly if one remains only a pupil. And why, then, should you not pluck at

my laurels? You respect me; but how if one day your respect should tumble? Take care that a falling statue does not strike you dead! You say you believe in Zarathustra? But of what importance is Zarathustra? You are my believers: but of what importance are all believers? You had not yet sought yourselves when you found me. Thus do all believers; therefore all belief is of so little account. Now I bid you lose me and find yourselves; and only when you have all denied me will I return to you Friedrich Nietzsche On this perfect day, when everything has become ripe and not only the grapes are growing brown, a ray of sunlight has fallen on to my life: I looked behind me, I looked before me, never have I seen so many and such good things together. Not in vain have I buried my forty-fourth year today, I was entitled to bury it - what there was of life in it is rescued, is immortal. The first book of the devaluation of all values~ the Songs of Zarathustra^ the-.JTWUighL-Qf .the Idols, my attempt to philosophize with a hammer - all of them gifts of this year T of its last quarter even! Now should I not be grateful to my whole ///gi-.AnH WHY I AM SO WISE The fortunateness or my existence, its uniqueness perhaps, lies in its fatality: to express it in the form of a riddle, as my father I have already died, as my mother I still live and grow old. This twofold origin, as it were from the highest and the lowest rung of the ladder of life, at once decadent and beginning - this if anything explains that neutrality, that freedom from party in relation to the total problem of life which perhaps distinguishes me. I have a subtler sense for signs of ascent and decline than any man has ever had, I am the teacher par excellence in this matter - I know both, I am both. - My father died at the age of thirty-six: he was delicate, lovable and morbid, like a being destined to pay this world only a passing visit - a gracious reminder of life rather than life itself. In the same year in which his life declined mine too declined: in the thirty-sixth year of my life I arrived at the lowest point of my vitality - I still lived, but without being able to see three paces in front of me. At that time - it was 1879 - I relinquished my Basel professorship, lived through the summer like a shadow in St Moritz and the following winter, the most sunless of my life, as a shadow in Naumburg. This was my minimum: 'The Wanderer and his Shadow' came into existence during the course of it. I undoubtedly knew all about shadows in those days ... In the following winter, the first winter I spent in Genoa, that sweetening and spiritualization which is virtually inseparable from an extreme poverty of blood and muscle produced 'Daybreak'. The perfect brightness and cheerfulness, even exuberance of spirit reflected in the said work is in my case compatible not only with the WHY I AM SO WISE!. profoundest physiological weakness, but even with an extremity of pain. In the midst of the torments which attended an uninterrupted three-day headache accompanied by the laborious vomiting of phlegm - I possessed a dialectical clarity par excellence and thought my way very cold-bloodedly through things for which when I am in better health I am not

enough of a climber, not refined, not cold enough. My readers perhaps know the extent to which I regard dialectics as a symptom of decadence, for example in the most famous case of all: in the case of Socrates. - All morbid disturbances of the intellect, even that semi-stupefaction consequent on fever, have remained to this day totally unfamiliar things to me, on their nature and frequency I had first to instruct myself by scholarly methods. My blood flows slowly. No one has ever been able to diagnose fever in me. A doctor who treated me for some time as a nervous case said at last: 'No! there is nothing wrong with your nerves, it is only I who am nervous.' Any kind of local degeneration absolutely undemonstrable; no organically originating stomach ailment, though there does exist, as a consequence of general exhaustion, a profound weakness of the gastric system. Condition of the eyes, sometimes approaching dangerously close to blindness, also only consequence, not causal: so that with every increase in vitality eyesight has also again improved. - Convalescence means with me a long, all too long succession of years - it also unfortunately means relapse, deterioration, periods of a kind of decadence. After all this do I need to say that in questions of decadence I am experienced? I have spelled it out forwards and backwards. Even that filigree art of grasping and comprehending in general, that finger for nuances, that psychology of 'looking around the corner' and whatever else characterizes me was learned only then, is the actual gift of that time in which everything in me became more subtle, observation itself together with all the organs of observation. To look from a morbid perspective towards healthier concepts and values, and again conversely to look down from the abundance and certainty of rich life into the secret labour of the instinct of ECCE HOMO decadence - that is what I have practised most, it has been my own particular field of experience, in this if in anything I am a master. I now have the skill and knowledge to invert perspectives: first reason why a 'revaluation of values' is perhaps possible at all to me alone. - Setting aside the fact that I am a decadent, I am also its antithesis. My proof of this is, among other things, that in combating my sick conditions I always instinctively chose the right means: while the decadent as such always chooses which one would do better to call hygiene so as not to mix it up with such pitiable things as Christianity, makes its effect dependent on victory over resentment: to free the soul of that - first step to recovery. 'Not by enmity is enmity ended, by friendship is enmity ended': this stands at the beginning of Buddha's teaching - it is not morality that speaks thus, it is physiology that speaks thus. - Resentment, born of weakness, to no one more harmful than to the weak man himself - in the opposite case, where a rich nature is the presupposition, a superfluous feeling to stay master of which is almost the proof of richness. He who knows the seriousness with which my philosophy has taken up the struggle against the feelings of vengefulness and vindictiveness even into the theory of 'free will' - my struggle against Christianity

is only a special instance of it - will understand why it is precisely here that I throw the light on my personal bearing, my sureness of instinct in practice. In periods of decadence I forbade them to myself as harmful; as soon as life was again sufficiently rich and proud for them I forbade them to myself as beneath me. That 'Russian fatalism' of which I spoke came forward in my case in the form of clinging tenaciously for years on end to almost intolerable situations, places, residences, company, once chance had placed me in them - it was better than changing them, than feeling them as capable of being changed - than rebelling against them ... In those days I took it deadly amiss if I was disturbed in this fatalism, if I was forcibly awakened from it - and to do this was in fact every time a deadly dangerous thing. - To accept oneself as a fate, not to desire oneself 'different' - in such conditions this is great rationality itself. War is another thing. I am by nature warlike. To attack is among my instincts. To be able to be an enemy, to be an enemy WHY I AM SO WISE - that perhaps presupposes a strong nature, it is in any event a condition of every strong nature. It needs resistances, consequently it seeks resistances: the aggressive pathos belongs as necessarily to strength as the feeling of vengefulness and vindictiveness does to weakness. Woman, for example, is vengeful: that is conditioned by her weakness, just as is her susceptibility to others' distress. - The strength of one who attacks has in the opposition he needs a kind of gauge; every growth reveals itself in the seeking out of a powerful opponent - or problem: for a philosopher who is warlike also challenges problems to a duel. The undertaking is to master, not any resistances that happen to present themselves, but those against which one has to bring all one's strength, suppleness and mastery of weapons - to master equal opponents... Equality in face of the enemy - first presupposition of an honest duel. Where one despises one cannot wage war; where one commands, where one sees something as beneath one, one has not to wage war. - My practice in warfare can be reduced to four propositions. Firstly: I attack only causes that are victorious - under certain circumstances I wait until they are victorious. Secondly: I attack only causes against which I would find no allies, where I stand alone - where I compromise only myself ... I have never taken a step in public which was not compromising: that is my criterion of right action. Thirdly: I never attack persons - I only employ the person as a strong magnifying glass with which one can make visible a general but furtive state of distress which is hard to get hold of. That was how I attacked David Strauss, more precisely the success with German 'culture' of a senile book - I thus caught that culture red-handed... That was how I attacked Wagner, more precisely the falseness, the hybrid instincts of our 'culture' which confuses the artful with the rich, the late with the great. Fourthly: I attack only things where any kind of personal difference is excluded, where there is no background of bad experience. On the contrary, to attack is with me a proof of good will, under certain circumstances of gratitude. I do honour, I confer

distinction when I associate my 17 ECCE HOMO name with a cause, a person: for or against - that is in this regard a matter of indifference to me. If I wage war on Christianity I have a right to do so, because I have never experienced anything disagreeable or frustrating from that direction - the most serious Christians have always been well disposed towards me. I myself, an opponent of Christianity *de rigueur*, am far from bearing a grudge against the individual for what is the fatality of millennia. - 8 May I venture to indicate one last trait of my nature which creates for me no little difficulty in my relations with others? I possess a perfectly uncanny sensitivity of the instinct for cleanliness, so that I perceive physiologically - smell - the proximity or - what am I saying? - the innermost parts, the 'entrails', of every soul ... I have in this sensitivity psychological antennae with which I touch and take hold of every secret: all the concealed dirt at the bottom of many a nature, perhaps conditioned by bad blood but whitewashed by education, is known to me almost on first contact. If I have observed correctly, such natures unendurable to my sense of cleanliness for their part also sense the caution of my disgust: they do not thereby become any sweeter-smelling ... As has always been customary with me - an extreme cleanliness in relation to me is a presupposition of my existence, I perish under unclean conditions I swim and bathe and splash continually as it were in water, in any kind of perfectly transparent and glittering element. This makes traffic with people no small test of my patience; my humanity consists, not in feeling for and with man, but in enduring that I do feel for and with him. My humanity is a continual self-overcoming. - But I have need of solitude, that is to say recovery, return to myself, the breath of a free light playful air.. . My entire Zarathustra is a dithyramb on solitude or, if I have been understood, on cleanliness. Fortunately not on pure folly. - He who has eyes for colours will call it diamond. 18 WHY ! AM SO \V Is! Disgust at mankind! at the 'rabble', has always been my greatest danger ... Do you want to hear the words in which Zarathustra speaks of redemption from disgust? Yet what happened to me? How did I free myself from disgust? Who rejuvenated my eyes? How did I fly to the height where the rabble no longer sit at the well? Did my disgust itself create wings and water-diving powers for me? Truly, I had to fly to the extremest height to find again the fountain of delight! Oh, I have found it, my brothers! Here, in the extremest height, the fountain of delight gushes up for me! And here there is a life at which no rabble drinks with me! You gush up almost too impetuously, fountain of delight! And in wanting to fill the cup, you often empty it again. And I still have to learn to approach you more discreetly: my heart still flows towards you all too impetuously: - my heart, upon which my summer burns, a short, hot, melancholy, over-joyful summer: how my summer-heart longs for your coolness! Gone is the lingering affliction of my spring! Gone the snowflakes of my malice in June! Summer have I become entirely, and summer-noonday - - a summer at

the extremest height with cold fountains and blissful stillness: oh come, my friends, that the stillness may become more blissful yet! For this is our height and our home: we live too nobly and boldly here for all unclean men and their thirsts. Only cast your pure eyes into the well of my delight, friends! You will not dim its sparkle! It shall laugh back at you with its purity. We build our nest in the tree Future: eagles shall bring food to us solitaries in their beaks! Truly, food in which no unclean men could join us! They would think they were eating fire and burn their mouths. Truly, we do not prepare a home here for unclean men! *9 ECCE HOMO Their bodies and their spirits would call our happiness a cave of ice! So let us live above them like strong winds, neighbours of the eagles, neighbours of the snow, neighbours of the sun: that is how strong winds live. And like a wind will I one day blow among them and with my spirit take away the breath of their spirit: thus my future will have it. Truly, Zarathustra is a strong wind to all flatlands; and he offers this advice to his enemies and to all that spews and spits: take care not to spit against the wind! WHY I AM SO CLEVER - Why do I know a few more things? Why am I so clever altogether? I have never reflected on questions that are none - I have not squandered myself. - I have, for example, no experience of actual religious difficulties. I am entirely at a loss to know to what extent I ought to have felt 'sinful'. I likewise lack a reliable criterion of a pang of conscience: from what one hears of it, a pang of conscience does not seem to me anything respectable... I should not like to leave an act in the lurch afterwards, I would as a matter of principle prefer to leave the evil outcome, the consequences, out of the question of values. When the outcome is evil one can easily lose the true eye for what one has done: a pang of conscience seems to me a kind of 'evil eye'. To honour to oneself something that went wrong all the more because it went wrong - that rather would accord with my morality. - 'God', 'immortality of the soul', 'redemption 'the Beyond', all those concepts to which I have given no attention and no time, not even as a child — perhaps I was never childish enough for it? - I have absolutely no knowledge of atheism as an outcome of reasoning, still less as an event: with me it is obvious by instinct. I am too inquisitive, too questionable, ^ too high spirited to rest content with a crude answer. God is a crude answer, a piece of indelicacy against us thinkers - fundamentally even a crude prohibition. You shall not think.... I am interested in quite a different way in a question upon which the 'salvation of mankind' depends far more than it does upon any kind of quaint curiosity of the theologians: the question of nutriment. One can for convenience' sake formulate 21 ECCE HOMO it thus: 'how to nourish yourself so as to attain your maximum of strength, of virtue in the Renaissance style, of moraline-free virtue?' - My experiences here are as bad as they possibly could be; I am astonished that I heard this question so late, that I learned 'reason' from these experiences so late. Only the perfect worthlessness of our German education - its 'idealism' - can to

some extent explain to me why on precisely this point I was backward to the point of holiness. This 'education' which from the first led me to a sight of realities so as to hunt after altogether problematic, so-called 'ideal' objectives, 'classical education' for example - as if it were not from the first an utterly fruitless undertaking to try to unite 'classical' and 'German' in one concept! It is, moreover, mirth-provoking - just think of a 'classically educated' Leipziger! - Until my very maturest years I did in fact eat badly - in the language of morals 'impersonally', 'selflessly', 'altruistically', for the salvation of cooks and other fellow Christians. With the aid of Leipzig cookery, for example, which accompanied my earliest study of Schopenhauer (1865), I very earnestly denied my 'will to live'. To ruin one's stomach so as to receive inadequate nutriment - the aforesaid cookery seems to me to solve this problem wonderfully well. (It is said that 1866 produced a change in this domain -.) But German cookery in general - what does it not have on its conscience! Soup before the meal (in Venetian cookery books of the sixteenth century still called *alia tedesca*); meat cooked to shreds, greasy and floury vegetables; the degeneration of puddings to paperweights! If one adds to this the downright bestial dinner-drinking habits of the ancient and by no means only the ancient Germans one will also understand the origin of the German spirit - disturbed intestines... The German spirit is an indigestion, it can have done with nothing. - But to the English diet too, which compared with the Germans, even with the French, is a kind of 'return to nature', that is to say to cannibalism, my own instinct is profoundly opposed; it seems to me to give the spirit heavy feet - the feet of Englishwomen.. . The best cookery is that of Piedmont. Alas - why I am so CLEVER holic drinks are no good for me; a glass of wine or beer a day is quite enough to make life for me a 'Vale of Tears' Munich is where my antipodes live. Granted I was a little late to grasp this - I experienced it really from childhood onwards. As a boy I believed wine-drinking to be, like tobacco-smoking, at first only a vanity of young men, later a habit. Perhaps the wine of Naumburg is in part to blame for this austere judgement. To believe that wine makes cheerful I would have to be a Christian, that is to say believe what is for precisely me an absurdity. Oddly enough, while I am put extremely out of sorts by small, much diluted doses of alcohol, I am almost turned into a sailor when it comes to strong doses. Even as a boy I showed how brave I was in this respect. To write a long Latin essay in a single night's sitting and then go on to make a fair copy of it, with the ambition in my pen to imitate in severity and concision my model Sallust, and to pour a quantity of grog of the heaviest calibre over my Latin, was even when I was a pupil of venerable Schulpforta in no way opposed to my physiology, nor perhaps to that of Sallust - however much it might have been to venerable Schulpforta.. . Later, towards the middle of life, I decided, to be sure, more and more strictly against any sort of 'spirituous' drink: an opponent of vegetarianism from experience, just

like Richard Wagner, who converted me, I cannot advise all more spiritual natures too seriously to abstain from alcohol absolutely. Water suffices... I prefer places in which there is everywhere opportunity to drink from flowing fountains (Nice, Turin, Sils); a small glass runs after me like a dog. In vino Veritas: it seems that here too I am again at odds with all the world over the concept 'truth' - with me the spirit moves over the water ... A couple more signposts from my morality. A big meal is easier to digest than one too small. That the stomach comes into action as a whole, first precondition of a good digestion. One has to know the size of one's stomach. For the same reason those tedious meals should be avoided which I call interrupted sacrificial feasts, those at the table d'hote. - No eating between meals, no coffee: coffee makes gloomy. 23 ECCE HOMO Tea beneficial only in the morning. Little, but strong: tea very detrimental and sicklying o'er the whole day if it is the slightest bit too weak. Each has here his own degree, often between the narrowest and most delicate limits. In a very agacant climate it is inadvisable to start with tea: one should start an hour earlier with a cup of thick oil-free cocoa. - Sit as little as possible; credit no thought not born in the open air and while moving freely about - in which the muscles too do not hold a festival. All prejudices come from the intestines. - Assiduity - I have said it once before - the actual sin against the holy spirit. - Most closely related to the question of nutriment is the question of place and climate. No one is free to live everywhere; and he who has great tasks to fulfil which challenge his entire strength has indeed in this matter a very narrow range of choice. The influence of climate on the metabolism, its slowing down, its speeding up, extends so far that a blunder in regard to place and climate can not only estrange anyone from his task but withhold it from him altogether: he never catches sight of it. His animalic vigor never grows sufficiently great for him to attain to that freedom overflowing into the most spiritual domain where he knows: that I alone can do ... A never so infinitesimal sluggishness of the intestines grown into a bad habit completely suffices to transform a genius into something mediocre, something 'German'; the German climate alone is enough to discourage strong and even heroic intestines. The tempo of the metabolism stands in an exact relationship to the mobility or lameness of the feet of the spirit; the 'spirit' itself is indeed only a species of this metabolism. Make a list of the places where there are and have been gifted men, where wit, refinement, malice are a part of happiness, where genius has almost necessarily made its home: they all possess an excellent dry air. Paris, Provence, Florence, Jerusalem, Athens - these names prove something: that genius is conditioned by dry air, 24 WHY I AM SO CLEVER clear sky that is to sav In rapid metabolism, In the possibility of again and again supplying oneself with great, even tremen- dous quantities of energy. I have in minci a ease in which a spirit which might have become significant and free became instead narrow, withdrawn, a grumpy specialist, merely through a

lack of instinctive subtlety in choice of climate. And I myself could in the end have become this case if sickness had not compelled me to reason, to reflect on reason in reality. Now, when from long practice I read climatic and meteorological effects off from myself as from a very delicate and reliable instrument and even on a short journey, from Turin to Milan for instance, verify on myself physiologically the change in degrees of humidity, I recall with horror the uncanny fact that my life up to the last ten years, the years when my life was in danger, was spent nowhere but in wrong places downright forbidden to me. Naumburg, Schulpforta, Thuringia in general, Leipzig, Basel, Venice - so many ill-fated places for my physiology. If I have no welcome memories at all of my whole childhood and youth, it would be folly to attribute this to so-called 'moral' causes - the undeniable lack of adequate company, for instance: for this lack exists today as it has always existed without preventing me from being brave and cheerful. Ignorance in physiology - accursed 'idealism' - is the real fatality in my life, the superfluous and stupid in it, something out of which nothing good grows, for which there is no compensation, no counter-reckoning. It is as a consequence of this 'idealism' that I elucidate to myself all the blunders, all the great deviations of instinct and 'modesties' which led me away from the task of my life, that I became a philologist for example - why not at least a physician or something else that opens the eyes? In my time at Basel my entire spiritual diet, the division of the day included, was a perfectly senseless abuse of extraordinary powers without any kind of provision for covering this consumption, without even reflection on consumption and replacement. Any more subtle selfishness, any protection by a commanding instinct was lacking, it was an equating of oneself 25 ECCE HOMO with everyone else, a piece of 'selflessness', a forgetting of one's distance - something I shall never forgive myself. When I was almost done for, because I was almost done for, I began to reflect on this fundamental irrationality of my life - 'idealism'. It was only sickness that brought me to reason. - 3 Selectivity in nutriment; selectivity in climate and place; - the third thing in which one may at no cost commit a blunder is selectivity in one's kind of recreation. Here too the degree to which a spirit is sui generis makes ever narrower the bounds of what is permitted, that is to say useful to him. In my case all reading is among my recreations: consequently among those things which free me from myself, which allow me to saunter among strange sciences and souls - which I no longer take seriously. It is precisely reading which helps me to recover from my seriousness. At times when I am deeply sunk in work you will see no books around me: I would guard against letting anyone speak or even think in my vicinity. And that is what reading would mean... Has it really been noticed that in that state of profound tension to which pregnancy condemns the spirit and fundamentally the entire organism, any chance event, any kind of stimulus from without has too vehement an effect, 'cuts' too deeply? One has to

avoid the chance event, the stimulus from without, as much as possible; a kind of self- walling-up is among the instinctual sagacities of spiritual pregnancy. Shall I allow a strange thought to climb secretly over the wall? - And that is what reading would mean. The times of work and fruitfulness are followed by the time of recreation: come hither, you pleasant, you witty, you clever books! Will they be German books? ... I have to reckon back half a year to catch myself with a book in my hand. But what was it? - An excellent study by Victor Brochard, *les sceptiques Grecs*, in which my *Laertiana* are also well employed. The Sceptics, the only honourable type among the two- and five-fold ambiguous philosophy - 26 WHY I AM so CLEVER SOPHICAL crowd! ... Otherwise I take flight almost always to the same hooks, really a small number, those hooks which have proved themselves precisely to me. It does not perhaps lie in my nature to read much or many kinds of things: a reading room makes me ill. Neither does it lie in my nature to love much or many kinds of things. Caution, even hostility towards new books is rather part of my instinct than 'tolerance', *Uargeur du coeur** and other forms of 'neighbour love' ... It is really only a small number of older Frenchmen to whom I return again and again: I believe only in French culture and consider everything in Europe that calls itself 'culture' a misunderstanding, not to speak of German culture.. . The few instances of high culture I have encountered in Germany have all been of French origin, above all Frau Cosima Wagner, by far the first voice I have heard in questions of taste. - That I do not read Pascal but love him, as the most instructive of all sacrifices to Christianity, slowly murdered first physically then psychologically, the whole logic of this most horrible form of inhuman cruelty; that I have something of Montaigne's wantonness in my spirit, who knows? perhaps also in my body; that my artist's taste defends the names Moliere, Corneille and Racine, not without wrath, against a disorderly genius such as Shakespeare: this does not ultimately exclude my finding the most recent Frenchmen also charming company. I cannot at all conceive in which century of history one could haul together such inquisitive and at the same time such delicate psychologists as one can in contemporary Paris: I name as a sample — for their number is by no means small, Messrs Paul Bourget, Pierre Loti, Gyp, Meilhac, Anatole France, Jules Lemaitre, or to pick out one of the stronger race, a genuine Latin to whom I am especially attached, Guy de Maupassant. Between ourselves, I prefer this generation even to their great teachers, who have all been ruined by German philosophy (M. Taine for example by Hegel, whom he has to thank for this misunderstanding of great human beings and ages). As far as Germany extends it ruins culture. It was only the war that 'redeemed' the spirit in France.. . Stendhal, one ECCE HOMO of the fairest accidents of my life - for whatever marks an epoch in my life has been brought to me by accident, never by a recommendation - is utterly invaluable with his anticipating psychologist's eye, with his grasp of facts which reminds one of the proximity of the greatest

man of the factual (ex ungue Napoleonem -); finally not least as an honest atheist, a rare, almost undiscoverable species in France - with all deference to Prosper Merimee.. . Perhaps I am even envious of Stendhal? He robbed me of the best atheist joke which precisely I could have made: 'God's only excuse is that he does not exist' I myself have said somewhere: what has hitherto been the greatest objection to existence? God... "~~~—— The highest conception of the lyric poet was given me by Heinrich Heine. I seek in vain in all the realms of millennia for an equally sweet and passionate music. He possesses that divine malice without which I cannot imagine perfection - I assess the value of people, of races according to how necessarily they are unable to separate the god from the satyr. - And how he employs German! It will one day be said that Heine and I have been by far the first artists of the German language - at an incalculable distance from everything which mere Germans have done with it. - I must be profoundly related to Byron's Manfred: I discovered all these abysses in myself - I was ripe for this work at thirteen. I have no words, only a look for those who dare to say the word Faust in the presence of Manfred. The Germans are incapable of any conception of greatness: proof Schumann. Expressly from wrath against this sugary Saxon, I composed a counter-overture to Manfred, of which Hans von Biilow said he had never seen the like on manuscript paper: it constituted a rape on Euterpe. - When I seek my highest formula for Shakespeare I find it always in that he conceived the type of Caesar. One cannot guess at things like this - one is it or one is not. The great poet creates only out 28 why I am so CLEVER of his own reality to the point at which he is afterwards unable to endure his own work . When I have taken a glance at my Zarathustra I walk up and down my room for half an hour unable to master an unendurable spasm of sobbing. - I know of no more heartrending reading than Shakespeare: what must a man have suffered to need to be a buffoon to this extent! - Is Hamlet understood? It is not doubt, it is certainty which makes mad... But to feel in this way one must be profound, abyss, philosopher.. . We fear truth.. . And, to confess it: I am instinctively certain that Lord Bacon is the originator, the self-tormentor of this uncanniest species of literature: what do I care about the pitiable chatter of American shallow-pates and muddle-heads? But the power for the mightiest reality of vision is not only compatible with the mightiest power for action, for the monstrous in action, for crime - // even presupposes it ... We do not know nearly enough about Lord Bacon, the first realist in every great sense of the word, to know what he did, what he wanted, what he experienced within himself.. . And the devil take it, my dear critics! Supposing I had baptized my Zarathustra with another name, for example with the name of Richard Wagner, the perspicuity of two millennia would not have sufficed to divine that the author of 'Human, All Too Human' is the visionary of Zarathustra 5 Here where I am speaking of the recreations of my life, I need to say a word to express my

gratitude for that which of all things in it has refreshed me by far the most profoundly and cordially. This was without any doubt my intimate association with Richard Wagner. I offer all my other human relationships cheap; but at no price would I relinquish from my life the Tribschen days, those days of mutual confidences, of cheerfulness, of sublime incidents - of profound moments I do not know what others may have experienced with Wagner: over our sky no cloud ever passed. - And with that I return again to 29 ECCE HOMO France - I cannot spare reasons, I can spare a mere curl of the lip for Wagnerians et hoc genus omne who believe they are doing honour to Wagner when they find him similar to themselves Constituted as I am, a stranger in my deepest instincts to everything German, so that the mere presence of a German hinders my digestion, my first contact with Wagner was also the first time in my life I ever drew a deep breath: I felt, I revered him as a being from outside, as the opposite, the incarnate protest against all 'German virtues'. - We who were children in the swamp-air of the fifties are necessarily pessimists regarding the concept 'German'; we cannot be anything but revolutionaries - we shall acquiesce in no state of things in which the bigot is on top. It is a matter of complete indifference to me if today he plays in different colours, if he dresses in scarlet and dons the uniform of a hussar.. . Very well! Wagner was a revolutionary - he fled from the Germans ... As an artist one has no home in Europe except in Paris: the delicatessen in all five senses of art which Wagner's art presupposes, the fingers for nuances, the psychological morbidity, is to be found only in Paris. Nowhere else does there exist such a passion in questions of form, this seriousness in mise en scene - it is the Parisian seriousness par excellence. There is in Germany absolutely no conception of the tremendous ambition which dwells in the soul of a Parisian artist. The German is good-natured - Wagner was by no means good-natured . But I have already said sufficient (in 'Beyond Good and Evil' §256) as to where Wagner belongs, in whom he has his closest relatives: the French late romantics, that high-flying and yet exhilarating kind of artists such as Delacroix, such as Berlioz, with a fondness for sickness, of incurability in their nature, sheer fanatics for expression, virtuosi through and through.. . Who was the first intelligent adherent of Wagner? Charles Baudelaire, the same as was the first to understand Delacroix, that typical decadent in whom an entire race of artists recognized themselves - he was perhaps also the last.. . What I have never forgiven Wagner? That he condescended to the Germans - that he became reichsdeutsch ... As far as Germany extends it ruins culture. - 30 why I AM SO < LEVER All in all I could not have endured my youth without Wagnerian music. For I was condemned to Germans. If one wants to get free from an unendurable pressure one needs hashish. Very well, I needed Wagner. Wagner is the counterpoison to everything German par excellence - still poison, I do not dispute it... From the moment there was a piano score of Tristan - my compliments, Herr von

Bulow! - I was a Wagnerian. The earliest works of Wagner I saw as beneath me - still too common, too 'German'.. . But I still today seek a work of a dangerous fascination, of a sweet and shuddery infinity equal to that of Tristan - I seek in all the arts in vain. All the strange- nesses of Leonardo da Vinci lose their magic at the first note of Tristan. This work is altogether Wagner's non plus ultra; he recuperated from it with the Meistersinger and the Ring. To become healthier — that is retrogression in the case of a nature such as Wagner ... I take it for a piece of good fortune of the first rank to have lived at the right time, and to have lived precisely among Germans, so as to be ripe for this work: my psychologist's inquisitiveness goes that far. The world is poor for him who has never been sick enough for this 'voluptuous- ness of hell': to employ a mystic's formula is permissible, almost obligatory, here. I think I know better than anyone what tremendous things Wagner was capable of, the fifty worlds of strange delights to which no one but he had wings; and as I am strong enough to turn even the most questionable and most perilous things to my own advantage and thus to become stronger, I call Wagner the great benefactor of my life. That in which we are related, that we have suffered more profoundly, from one another also, than men of this century are capable of suffering, will eternally join our names together again and again; and as surely as Wagner is among Germans merely a misunderstanding, just as surely am I and always will be. - Two centuries of psychological and artistic discipline first, my Herr Germans!.. . But one cannot catch up that amount. - ECCE HOMO - I shall say another word for the most select ears: what I really want from music. That it is cheerful and profound, like an afternoon in October. That it is individual, wanton, tender, a little sweet woman of lowness and charm I shall never admit that a German could know what music is. What one calls German musicians, the greatest above all, are foreigners, Slavs, Croats, Italians, Netherlands - or Jews: otherwise Germans of the strong race, extinct Germans, like Heinrich Schiitz, Bach and Handel. I myself am still sufficient of a Pole to exchange the rest of music for Chopin; for three reasons I exclude Wagner's Siegfried Idyll, perhaps also a few things by Liszt, who excels all other musicians in the nobility of his orchestral tone; finally all that has grown up beyond the Alps - this side... I would not know how to get on without Rossini, even less without my south in music, the music of my Venetian maestro Pietro Gasti. And when I say beyond the Alps I am really saying only Venice. When I seek another word for music I never find any other word than Venice. I do not know how to distinguish between tears and music - I do not know how to think of happiness, of the south, without a shudder of faintheartedness. Lately I stood at the bridge in the brown night. From afar there came a song: a golden drop, it swelled across the trembling surface. Gondolas, lights, music - drunken it swam out into the gloom My soul, a stringed instrument, touched by invisible hands sang to itself in reply a gondola song, and

trembled with gaudy happiness. - Was anyone listening? M WHY I AM SO (I.I \ IK 8 In all this in selection of nutriment, of place and climate, of recreation - there commands an instinct of self-preservation which manifests itself most unambiguously as an instinct for self-defence. Not to see many things, not to hear them, not to let them approach one - first piece of ingenuity, first proof that one is no accident but a necessity. The customary word for this self-defensive instinct is taste. Its imperative commands, not only to say No when Yes would be a piece of 'selflessness', but also to say No as little as possible. To separate oneself, to depart from that to which No would be required again and again. The rationale is that defensive expenditures, be they never so small, become a rule, a habit, lead to an extraordinary and perfectly superfluous impoverishment. Our largest expenditures are our most frequent small ones. Warding off, not letting come close, is an expenditure — one should not deceive oneself over this — a strength squandered on negative objectives. One can merely through the constant need to ward off become too weak any longer to defend oneself. - Suppose I were to step out of my house and discover, instead of calm and aristocratic Turin, the German provincial town: my instinct would have to blockade itself so as to push back all that pressed upon it from this flat and cowardly world. Or suppose I discovered the German metropolis, that builded vice where nothing grows, where every kind of thing, good and bad, is dragged in. Would I not in face of it have to become a hedgehog! - But to have spikes is an extravagance, a double luxury even if one is free to have no spikes but open hands... ^^m Another form of sagacity and self-defence consists in reacting as seldom as possible and withdrawing from situations and relation- ships in which one would be condemned as it were to suspend one's 'freedom', one's initiative, and become a mere reagent. I take as a parable traffic with books. The scholar, who really does nothing but 'trundle' books - the philologist at a modest assessment about 200 a day — finally loses altogether the ability 33 ECCE HOMO to think for himself. If he does not trundle he does not think. He replies to a stimulus (- a thought he has read) when he thinks - finally he does nothing but react. The scholar expends his entire strength in affirmation and denial, in criticizing what has already been thought - he himself no longer thinks . The instinct for self-defence has in his case become soft; otherwise he would defend himself against books. The scholar - a decadent. - This I have seen with my own eyes: natures gifted, rich and free already in their thirties 'read to ruins', mere matches that have to be struck if they are to ignite - emit 'thoughts'. - Early in the morning at the break of day, in all the freshness and dawn of one's strength, to read a book - I call that vicious! - 9 At this point I can no longer avoid actually answering the question how one becomes what one is. And with that I touch on the masterpiece in the art of self-preservation - of selfishness For assuming that the task, the vocation, the destiny of the task exceeds the average measure by a significant degree, there would be

no greater danger than to catch sight of oneself with this task. That one becomes what one is presupposes that one does not have the remotest idea what one is. From this point of view even the blunders of life - the temporary sidepaths and wrong turnings, the delays, the 'modesties', the seriousness squandered on tasks which lie outside the task - have their own meaning and value. They are an expression of a great sagacity, even the supreme sagacity: where nosce te ipsum would be the recipe for destruction, self-forgetfulness, ^{-misunderstanding, self-diminution, -narrowing, -mediocrating becomes reason itself. Expressed morally: love of one's neighbour, living for others and other things can be the defensive measure for the preservation of the sternest selfishness. This is the exceptional case in which I, contrary to my rule and conviction, take the side of the 'selfless' drives: here they work in the service of selfishness, self-cultivation.

- The entire surface of consciousness - 34 WHY I AM so CLBVBI consciousness is a surface has to be kept clear of any of the great imperatives. Even the grand words, the grand attitudes must be guarded against! All of them represent a danger that the instinct will 'understand itself too early'. In the meantime the organizing 'idea' destined to rule grows and grows in the depths - it begins to command, it slowly leads back from sidepaths and wrong turnings, it prepares individual qualities and abilities which will one day prove themselves indispensable as means to achieving the whole - it constructs the ancillary capacities one after the other before it gives any hint of the dominating task, of the 'goal', 'objective', 'meaning'. - Re- garded from this side my life is simply wonderful. For the task of a revaluation of values more capacities perhaps were required than have dwelt together in one individual, above all antithetical capacities which however are not allowed to disturb or destroy one another. Order of rank among capacities; distance; the art of dividing without making inimical; mixing up nothing, 'recon- ciling' nothing; a tremendous multiplicity which is none the less the opposite of chaos - this has been the precondition, the protracted secret labour and artistic working of my instinct. The magnitude of its higher protection was shown in the fact I have at no time had the remotest idea what was growing within me - that all my abilities one day leapt forth suddenly ripe, in their final perfection. I cannot remember ever having taken any trouble - no trace of struggle can be discovered in my life, I am the opposite of an heroic nature. To 'want' something, to 'strive' after something, to have a 'goal', a 'wish' in view - I know none of this from experience. Even at this moment I look out upon my future - a distant future! - as upon a smooth sea: it is ruffled by no desire. I do not want in the slightest that anything should become other than it is; I do not want myself to become other than I am.. . But that is how I have always lived. I have harboured no desire. Someone who after his forty- fourth year can say he has never striven after honours, after women, after money\ - Not that I could not have had them Thus, for example, I one day became a university professor - I 35

ECCE HOMO had never had the remotest thought of such a thing, for I was barely twenty-four years old. Thus two years earlier I was one day a philologist: in the sense that my first philological work, my beginning in any sense, was requested by my teacher Ritschl for his 'Rheinisches Museum' {Ritschl - I say it with respect - the only scholar gifted with genius whom I have encountered up to the present day. He was characterized by that pleasant depravity which distinguishes us Thuringians and which can render even a German sympathetic - to get to the truth we even prefer to go by secret paths. I should not with these words like to have in any way undervalued my close compatriot, the sagacious Leopold von Ranke .) IO - I shall be asked why I have really narrated all these little things which according to the traditional judgement are matters of indifference: it will be said that in doing so I harm myself all the more if I am destined to fulfil great tasks. Answer: these little things - nutriment, place, climate, recreation, the whole casuistry of selfishness - are beyond all conception of greater importance than anything that has been considered of importance hitherto. It is precisely here that one has to begin to learn anew. Those things which mankind has hitherto pondered seriously are not even realities, merely imaginings, more strictly speaking lies from the bad instincts of sick, in the profoundest sense injurious natures - all the concepts 'God', 'soul', 'virtue', 'sin', 'the Beyond', 'truth', 'eternal life' . But the greatness of human nature, its 'divinity', has been sought in them All questions of politics, the ordering of society, education have been falsified down to their foundations because the most injurious men have been taken for great men - because contempt has been taught for the 'little' things, which is to say for the fundamental affairs of life.. . Now, when I compare myself with the men who have hitherto been honoured as pre-eminent men the distinction is palpable. I do not count these supposed 56 WHY I AM so CLEVER 'pre-eminent men' as belonging to mankind at all - to me they are the refuse of mankind, abortive offspring of sickness and vengeful instincts: they are nothing but pernicious, fundamentally incurable monsters who take revenge on life ... I want to be the antithesis of this: it is my privilege to possess the highest subtlety for all the signs of healthy instincts. Every morbid trait is lacking in me; even in periods of severe illness I did not become morbid; a trait of fanaticism will be sought in vain in my nature. At no moment of my life can I be shown to have adopted any kind of arrogant or pathetic posture. The pathos of attitudes does not belong to greatness; whoever needs attitudes at all is false.. . Beware of all picturesque men! - Life has been easy for me, easiest when it demanded of me the most difficult things. Anyone who saw me during the seventy days of this autumn when I was uninterruptedly creating nothing but things of the first rank which no man will be able to do again or has done before, bearing a responsibility for all the coming millennia, will have noticed no trace of tension in me, but rather an overflowing freshness and cheerfulness. I never

ate with greater relish, I never slept better. - I know of no other way of dealing with great tasks than that of play: this is, as a sign of greatness, an essential precondition. The slightest constraint, the gloomy mien, any kind of harsh note in the throat are all objections to a man, how much more to his work! . One must have no nerves . To suffer from solitude is likewise an objection - I have always suffered only from the 'multitude' ... At an absurdly early age, at the age of seven, I already knew that no human word would ever reach me: has anyone ever seen me sad on that account? - Still today I treat everyone with the same geniality, I am even full of consideration for the basest people: in all this there is not a grain of arrogance, of secret contempt. He whom I despise divines that I despise him: through my mere existence I enrage everything that has bad blood in its veins.. . My formula for greatness in a human being is amor fati\ that one wants nothing to be other than it is, not in the future, not in the past, not in all eternity. Not merely 37 ECCE HOMO to endure that which happens of necessity, still less to dissemble it - all idealism is untruthfulness in the face of necessity - but to love it... WHY I WRITE SUCH GOOD BOOKS I am one thing, my writings are another. - Here, before I speak of these writings themselves, I shall touch on the question of their being understood or not understood. I shall do so as perfunctorily as is fitting: for the time for this question has certainly not yet come. My time has not yet come, some are born posthumously. - One day or other institutions will be needed in which people live and teach as I understand living and teaching: perhaps even chairs for the interpretation of Zarathustra will be established. But it would be a complete contradiction of myself if I expected ears and hands for my truths already today: that I am not heard today, that no one today knows how to take from me, is not only comprehensible; it even seems to me right. I do not want to be taken for what I am not - and that requires that I do not take myself for what I am not. To say it again, little of 'ill will' can be shown in my life; neither would I be able to speak of barely a single case of 'literary ill will'. On the other hand all too much of pure folly\ ... It seems to me that to take a book of mine into his hands is one of the rarest distinctions anyone can confer upon himself - I even assume he removes his shoes when he does so - not to speak of boots.. . When Doctor Heinrich von Stein once honestly complained that he understood not one word of my Zarathustra, I told him that was quite in order: to have understood, that is to say experienced^ six sentences of that book would raise one to a higher level of mortals than 'modern' man could attain to. How could I, with this feeling of distance, even want the 'modern men' I know - to read me! - My triumph is 39 ECCE HOMO precisely the opposite of Schopenhauer's - I say 'non legor, non legar'\ - Not that I should like to underestimate the pleasure which the innocence in the rejection of my writings has given me. This very summer just gone, at a time when, with my own weighty, too heavily weighty literature, I was perhaps throwing all the rest of

literature off its balance, a professor of Berlin University kindly gave me to understand that I ought really to avail myself of a different form: no one read stuff like mine. - In the end it was not Germany but Switzerland which offered me the two extreme cases. An essay of Dr V. Widmann in the Bund on 'Beyond Good and Evil' under the title 'Nietzsche's Dangerous Book', and a general report on my books as a whole on the part of Herr Karl Spitteler, also in the Bund, constitute a maximum in my life - of what I take care not to say. The latter, for example, dealt with my Zarathustra as an advanced exercise in style, with the request that I might later try to provide some content; Dr Widmann expressed his respect for the courage with which I strive to abolish all decent feelings. - Through a little trick of chance every sentence here was, with a consistency I had to admire, a truth stood on its head: remarkably enough, all one had to do was to 'revalue all values' in order to hit the nail on the head with regard to me - instead of hitting my head with a nail.. . All the more reason for me to attempt an explanation. - Ultimately, no one can extract from things, books included, more than he already knows. What one has no access to through experience one has no ear for. Now let us imagine an extreme case: that a book speaks of nothing but events which lie outside the possibility of general or even of rare experience - that it is the first language for a new range of experiences. In this case simply nothing will be heard, with the acoustical illusion that where nothing is heard there is nothing.. . This is in fact my average experience and, if you like, the originality of my experience. Whoever believed he had understood something of me had dressed up something out of me after his own image - not uncommonly an antithesis of me, for instance an 'idealist'; whoever had understood nothing of me 40 WHY I WRITE!-. SUCH GOOD HOOKS denied that I came into consideration at all. - The word 'superman' to designate a type that has turned out supremely well, in antithesis to 'modern' men, to 'good' men, to Christians and other nihilists - a word which, in the mouth of a Zarathustra, the destroyer of morality, becomes a very thoughtful word - has almost everywhere been understood with perfect innocence in the sense of those values whose antithesis makes its appearance in the figure of Zarathustra: that is to say as an 'idealistic' type of higher species of man, half 'saint', half 'genius'... Other learned cattle caused me on its account to be suspected of Darwinism; even the 'hero cult' of that great unconscious and involuntary counterfeiter Carlyle which I rejected so maliciously has been recognized in it. He into whose ear I whispered he ought to look around rather for a Cesare Borgia than for a Parsifal did not believe his ears. - That I am utterly incurious about discussions of my books, especially by newspapers, will have to be forgiven me. My friends, my publishers know this and do not speak to me about such things. In a particular instance I once had a sight of all the sins that had been committed against a single book - it was 'Beyond Good and Evil'; I could tell a pretty story about that.

Would you believe it that the 'Nationalzeitung' - a Prussian newspaper, for my foreign readers - I myself read, if I may say so, only the Journal des Debats - could in all seriousness understand the book as a 'sign of the times', as the real genuine junker philosophy for which the 'Kreuzzeitung' merely lacked the courage?... This was said for Germans: for I have readers everywhere else - nothing but choice intelligences of proved character brought up in high positions and duties; I have even real geniuses among my readers. In Vienna, in St Petersburg, in Stockholm, in Copenhagen, in Paris and New York - I have been discovered everywhere: I have not been in Europe's flatland Germany 4i ECCE HOMO And to confess it, I rejoice even more over my non-readers, such as have never heard either my name or the word philoso- phy; but wherever I go, here in Turin for example, every face grows more cheerful and benevolent at the sight of me. What has flattered me the most is that old market-women take great pains to select together for me the sweetest of their grapes. That is how far one must be a philosopher ... It is not in vain that the Poles are called the French among the Slavs. A charming Russian lady would not mistake for a moment where I belong. I cannot succeed in becoming solemn, the most I can achieve is embarrassment ... To think German, to feel German - I can do everything, but that is beyond my powers.. . My old teacher Ritschl went so far as to maintain that I conceived even my philological essays like a Parisian romancier - absurdly exciting. In Paris itself there is astonishment over 'toutes mes audaces et finesses' - the expression is Monsieur Taine's -; I fear that with me there is up to the highest forms of the dithyramb an admixture of that salt which never gets soggy - 'German' - esprit ... I cannot do otherwise, so help me God! Amen. - We all know, some even know from experience, what a longears is. Very well, I dare to assert that I possess the smallest ears. This is of no little interest to women - it seems to me they feel themselves better understood by me? ... I am the anti-ass par excellence and therewith a world-historical monster - I am, in Greek and not only in Greek, the Anti-Christ 3 I know my privileges as a writer to some extent; in individual cases it has been put to me how greatly habituation to my writings 'ruins' taste. One can simply no longer endure other books, philosophical ones least of all. To enter this noble and delicate world is an incomparable distinction - to do so one absolutely must not be a German; it is in the end a distinction one has to have earned. But he who is related to me through loftiness of will experiences when he reads me real ecstasies of 42 why i win ii SUCH GOOD hooks learning: tor I conic from heights DO birel has ever soared to, I know abysses into which no toot has ever yet strayed. I have becil told it is impossible to put I book of mine down I even disturb the night's rest.. . There is altogether no prouder and at the same time more exquisite kind of book than my books they attain here and there the highest thing that can be attained on earth, cynicism; one needs the most delicate fingers as well as the bravest fists if one is to master

them. Any infirmity of soul excludes one from them once and for all, any dyspepsia, even, does so: one must have no nerves, one must have a joyful belly. Not only does the poverty, the hole-and-corner air of a soul exclude it from them - cowardice, uncleanness, secret revengefulness in the entrails does so far more: a word from me drives all bad instincts into the face. I have among my acquaintances several experimental animals on whom I bring home to myself the various, very instructively various reactions to my writings. Those who want to have nothing to do with their contents, my so-called friends for example, become 'impersonal': they congratulate me on having 'done it' again - progress is apparent, too, in a greater cheerfulness of tone. . . The completely vicious 'spirits', the 'beautiful souls', the thoroughly and utterly mendacious have no idea at all what to do with these books - consequently they see the same as beneath them, the beautiful consistency of all 'beautiful souls'. The horned cattle among my acquaintances, mere Germans if I may say so, give me to understand they are not always of my opinion, though they are sometimes ... I have heard this said even of Zarathustra. . . Any 'feminism' in a person, or in a man, likewise closes the gates on me: one will never be able to enter this labyrinth of daring knowledge. One must never have spared oneself, harshness must be among one's habits, if one is to be happy and cheerful among nothing but hard truths. When I picture a perfect reader, I always picture a monster of courage and curiosity, also something supple, cunning, cautious, a born adventurer and discoverer. Finally: I would not know how to say better to whom at bottom alone I speak than Zarathustra has said it: to whom alone does he want to narrate his riddle? 43

ECCE HOMO To you, the bold venturers and adventurers, and whoever has embarked with cunning sails upon dreadful seas, to you who are intoxicated with riddles, who take pleasure in twilight, whose soul is lured with flutes to every treacherous abyss - for you do not desire to feel for a rope with cowardly hand; and where you can guess you hate to calculate I shall at the same time also say a general word on my style. To communicate a state, an inner tension of pathos through signs, including the tempo of these signs - that is the meaning of every style; and considering that the multiplicity of inner states is in my case extraordinary, there exists in my case the possibility of many styles - altogether the most manifold art of style any man has ever had at his disposal. Every style is good which actually communicates an inner state, which makes no mistake as to the signs, the tempo of the signs, the gestures - all rules of phrasing are art of gesture. My instinct is here infallible. - Good style in itself - a piece of pure folly, mere 'idealism', on a par with the 'beautiful in itself', the 'good in itself, the 'thing in itself. . . Always presupposing there are ears - that there are those capable and worthy of a similar pathos, that those are not lacking to whom one ought to communicate oneself. - My Zarathustra for example is at present still looking for them - alas! he will have to look for a long time yet! One has to be worthy of

assaying him... And until then there will be no one who comprehends the art which has here been squandered: no one has ever had more of the new, the unheard-of, the really new-created in artistic means to squander. That such a thing was possible in the German language remained to be proved: I myself would previously have most hotly disputed it. Before me one did not know what can be done with the German language - what can be done with language as such. The art of grand rhythm, the grand style of phrasing, as the expression of a WHY I WRITE SI (M GOOD HOOKS tremendous rise and tall of sublime, of superhuman passion, was first discovered by me; with a dithyramb such as the last of the third Xarathustra, entitled 'The Seven Seals', I Hew a thousand miles beyond that which has hitherto been called poesy. 5 - That out of my writings there speaks a psychologist who has not his equal, that is perhaps the first thing a good reader will notice - a reader such as I deserve, who reads me as good old philologists read their Horace. The propositions over which everybody is in fundamental agreement - not to speak of everybody's philosophers, the moralists and other hollow-heads and cabbage-heads - appear with me as naive blunders: for example that belief that 'unegoistic' and 'egoistic' are antitheses, while the ego itself is merely a 'higher swindle', an 'ideal'. There are neither egoistic nor unegoistic actions: both concepts are psychologically nonsense. Or the proposition 'man strives after happiness'... Or the proposition 'happiness is the reward of virtue' ... Or the proposition 'pleasure and displeasure are opposites'... The Circe of mankind, morality, has falsified all psychologica to its very foundations - has moralised it - to the point of the frightful absurdity that love is supposed to be something 'unegoistic'... One has to be set firmly upon oneself one has to stand bravely upon one's own two legs, otherwise one cannot love at all. In the long run the little women know that all too well: they play the deuce with selfless, with merely objective men... Dare I venture in addition to suggest that I know these little women? It is part of my Dionysian endowment. Who knows? perhaps I am the first psychologist of the eternal- womanly. They all love me - an old story: excepting the abortive women, the 'emancipated' who lack the stuff for chil- dren. - Happily I am not prepared to be torn to pieces: the complete woman tears to pieces when she loves... I know these amiable maenads.. Ah, what a dangerous, creeping, #-«Ay ?&^ ECCE HOMO subterranean little beast of prey it is! And so pleasant with it! ... A little woman chasing after her revenge would over-run fate itself. - The woman is unspeakably more wicked than the man, also cleverer; goodness in a woman is already a form of degeneration ... At the bottom of all so-called 'beautiful souls' there lies a physiological disadvantage - I shall not say all I could or I should become medicynical. The struggle for equal rights is even a symptom of sickness: every physician knows that. - The more a woman is a woman the more she defends herself tooth and nail against rights in general: for the state of nature, the eternal war between the sexes

puts her in a superior position by far. - Have there been ears for my definition of love? it is the only one worthy of a philosopher. Love - in its methods war, in its foundation the mortal hatred of the sexes. Has my answer been heard to the question how one cures - 'redeems' - a woman? One makes a child for her. The woman has need of children, the man is always only the means: thus spoke Zarathustra. - 'Emancipation of woman' - is the instinctive hatred of the woman who has turned out ill, that is to say is incapable of bearing, for her who has turned out well - the struggle against 'man' is always only means, subterfuge, tactic. When they elevate themselves as 'woman in herself, as 'higher woman', as 'idealist' woman, they want to lower the general level of rank of woman; no surer means for achieving that than grammar school education, trousers and the political rights of voting cattle. At bottom the emancipated are the anarchists in the world of the 'eternal-womanly', the under-privileged whose deepest instinct is revenge.. . An entire species of the most malevolent 'idealism' - which, by the way, also occurs in men, for example in the case of Henrik Ibsen, that typical old maid - has the objective of poisoning the good conscience, the naturalness in sexual love.. . And so as to leave no doubt as to my opinion in this matter, which is as honest as it is strict, I would like to impart one more clause of my moral code against vice: with the word vice I combat every sort of anti-nature or, if one likes beautiful words, idealism. The clause reads: 'The preaching 46 WHY I \\\ Kill SUCH (.<><> I) HOOKS of chastity is a public incitement to anti-nature. Every expression of contempt for the sexual life, every befouling of it through the concept "impure", is the crime against life is the intrinsic sin against the holy spirit of life.' To give an idea of me as a psychologist I take a curious piece of psychology which occurs in 'Beyond Good and Evil' - I forbid, by the way, any conjecture as to whom I am describing in this passage: 'The genius of the heart as it is possessed by that great hidden one, the tempter god and born piper of consciences whose voice knows how to descend into the underworld of every soul, who says no word and gives no glance in which there lies no touch of enticement, to whose mastery belongs knowing how to seem - not what he is but what to those who follow him is one constraint more to press ever closer to him, to follow him ever more inwardly and thoroughly The genius of the heart who makes everything loud and self-satisfied fall silent and teaches it to listen, who smooths rough souls and gives them a new desire to savour - the desire to lie still as a mirror, that the deep sky may mirror itself in them The genius of the heart who teaches the stupid and hasty hand to hesitate and grasp more delicately; who divines the hidden and forgotten treasure, the drop of goodness and sweet spirituality under thick and opaque ice, and is a divining-rod for every grain of gold which has lain long in the prison of much mud and sand... The genius of the heart from whose touch everyone goes away richer, not favoured and surprised, not as if blessed and oppressed with the goods of others, but richer in himself,

newer to himself than before, broken open, blown upon and sounded out by a thawing wind, more uncertain perhaps, more delicate, more fragile, more broken, but full of hopes that as yet have no names, full of new will and current, full of new ill will and counter current.. ' THE BIRTH OF TRAGEDY In order to be just to 'The Birth of Tragedy' (1872) one will have to forget a few things. It made its effect and even exercised fascination through what was wrong with it - through its application to Wagnerism, as if this were a symptom of a beginning. That is what made this book an event in Wagner's life: it was only from then on that great hopes surrounded the name Wagner. Even today people remind me, sometimes in the middle of Parsifal, that it is really / who have it on my conscience that so high an opinion of the cultural value of this movement has come to predominate. - I have often found the book cited as 'the Rebirth of Tragedy out of the Spirit of Music': people have had ears only for a new formula for the art, the intention, the task of Wagner - what of value was concealed in the book was thereby not listened to. 'Hellenism and Pessimism': that would have been a less ambiguous title: that is to say as a first instruction in how the Greeks got rid of pessimism - with what they overcame it.. . Precisely tragedy is the proof that the Greeks were no pessimists: Schopenhauer blundered in this as he blundered in everything. - Taken up and viewed impartially, 'The Birth of Tragedy' looks very untimely: one would not dream it was begun amid the thunders of the battle of Worth. I thought these problems through before the walls of Metz, in cold September nights while serving in the medical corps; one would rather believe the book to be fifty years older. It is politically indifferent - 'un-German' one would say today - it smells offensively Hegelian, it is in only a few formulas infected with the cadaverous perfume of 48 lilt Ml i< ill 01 i RAGEDY Schopenhauer. An 'idea* the antithesis Dionysian and Apollo man translated into the metaphysical; history itself as the evolution of this 'idea'; in tragedy this antithesis elevated to a unity; from this perspective things which had never before caught sight of one another suddenly confronted with one another, illuminated by one another and comprehended... for example opera and revolution.. . The book's two decisive novelties are, firstly the understanding of the dionysian phenom- enon in the case of the Greeks - it offers the first psychology of this phenomenon, it sees in it the sole root of the whole of Hellenic art -. The other novelty is the understanding of Socratism: Socrates for the first time recognized as an agent of Hellenic disintegration, as a typical decadent. 'Rationality' against instinct. 'Rationality' at any price as dangerous, as a force undermining life! - A profound hostile silence with regard to Christianity throughout the book. Christianity is neither Apollo- nian nor Dionysian, it negates all aesthetic values - the only values 'The Birth of Tragedy' recognizes: it is in the profoundest sense nihilistic, while in the Dionysian symbol there is attained the extreme limit of affirmation. In one place the Christian priests are

alluded to as a 'malicious species of dwarfs', as 'sub-terraneans'... This beginning is remarkable beyond all measure. I had discovered the only likeness and parallel to my own innermost experience which history possesses - I had therewith become the first to comprehend the wonderful phenomenon of the dionysian. By recognizing Socrates as a decadent I likewise offered a quite unambiguous proof of how little the certainty of my psychological grasp stood in danger of influence from any kind of moral idiosyncrasy - morality itself as a symptom of decadence is a novelty, a unique event of the first order in the history of knowledge. How high above and far beyond the pitiable shallow-pated chatter about optimism contra pessimism I had 49 ECCE HOMO leapt with these conceptions! - I was the first to see the real antithesis - the degenerated instinct which turns against life with subterranean vengefulness (- Christianity, the philosophy of Schopenhauer, in a certain sense already the philosophy of Plato, the whole of idealism as typical forms) and a formula of supreme affirmation born out of fullness, of superfluity, an affirmation without reservation even of suffering, even of guilt, even of all that is strange and questionable in existence. This ultimate, joyfullest, boundlessly exuberant Yes to life is not only the highest insight, it is also the profoundest, the insight most strictly confirmed and maintained by truth and knowledge. Nothing that is can be subtracted, nothing is dispensable - the sides of existence rejected by Christians and other nihilists are even of endlessly higher rank in the order of rank of values than that which the decadence instinct may approve of and call good. To grasp this requires courage and, as a condition of this, a superfluity of strength: for precisely as far as courage may dare to go forward, precisely by this measure of strength does one approach truth. Recognition, affirmation of reality is for the strong man as great a necessity as is for the weak man, under the inspiration of weakness, cowardice and flight in the face of reality - the 'ideal'.. They are not at liberty to know: decadents need the lie - it is one of the conditions of their existence. - He who not only understands the word 'dionysian' but understands himself in the word 'dionysian' needs no refutation of Plato or of Christianity or of Schopenhauer - he smells the decomposition... 3 The extent to which I therewith discovered the concept 'tragic', the knowledge at last attained of what the psychology of tragedy is, I most recently expressed in the Twilight of the Idols. 'Affirmation of life even in its strangest and sternest problems; the will to life rejoicing in its own inexhaustibility through the sacrifice of its highest types - that is what I called dionysian, that 50 THE BIRTH OF TRAGEDY is what I recognized as the bridge to the psychology of the tragic poet. Not so as to get rid of pity and terror, not so as to purify oneself of a dangerous emotion through its vehement discharge - it was thus Aristotle misunderstood it -: but, beyond pity and terror, to realise in oneself the eternal joy of becoming - the joy which also encompasses joy in destruction In this sense I have the right to understand myself

as the first tragic philosopher - that is to say the extremest antithesis and antipodes of a pessimistic philosopher. Before me this transposition of the dionysian into a philosophical pathos did not exist: tragic wisdom was lacking - I have sought in vain for signs of it even among the great Greeks of philosophy, those of the two centuries before Socrates. I retained a doubt in the case of Heraclitus, in whose vicinity in general I feel warmer and more well than anywhere else. Affirmation of transitoriness and destruction, the decisive element in a dionysian philosophy, affirmation of antithesis and war, becoming with a radical rejection even of the concept 'being' - in this I must in any event recognize what is most closely related to me of anything that has been thought hitherto. The doctrine of 'eternal recurrence', that is to say of the unconditional and endlessly repeated circular course of all things - this doctrine of Zarathustra could possibly already have been taught by Heraclitus. At least the Stoa, which inherited almost all its fundamental ideas from Heraclitus, shows traces of it. - A tremendous hope speaks out of this writing. I have in the end no reason whatever to renounce the hope for a dionysian future of music. Let us look a century ahead, let us suppose that my attentat on two millennia of anti-nature and the violation of man succeeds. That party of life which takes in hand the greatest of all tasks, the higher breeding of humanity, together with the remorseless destruction of all degenerate and parasitic elements, will again make possible on earth that superfluity of life 5i ECCE HOMO out of which the dionysian condition must again proceed. I promise a tragic age: the supreme art in the affirmation of life, tragedy, will be reborn when mankind has behind it the consciousness of the harshest but most necessary wars without suffering from it ... A psychologist might add that what I in my youthful years heard in Wagnerian music had nothing at all to do with Wagner; that when I described dionysian music I described that which I had heard - that I had instinctively to translate and transfigure into the latest idiom all I bore within me. The proof of this, as strong a proof as can be, is my essay 'Wagner in Bayreuth': in all the psychologically decisive passages I am the only person referred to - one may ruthlessly insert my name or the word 'Zarathustra' wherever the text gives the word Wagner. The entire picture of the dithyrambic artist is a picture of the pre-existent poet of Zarathustra, sketched out with abysmal profundity and without so much as touching on the Wagnerian reality for a moment. Wagner himself had an idea of this: he failed to recognize himself in the essay. - The 'Bayreuth idea' had likewise transformed itself into something that those who know my Zarathustra will find no riddle: into that great noontide when the most select dedicate themselves to the greatest of all tasks - who knows? the vision of a festival I shall yet live to see.. . The pathos of the first pages is world-historic; the glance which is spoken of is the actual glance of Zarathustra; Wagner, Bayreuth, the whole petty German wretchedness, is a cloud in which an endless fata morgana of the

future is reflected. Even psychologically all the decisive traits of my own nature are worked into that of Wagner - the proximity to one another of the brightest and most fateful forces, the will to power as it has never been possessed by any man, the ruthless bravery in the things of the spirit, the boundless strength to learn without the will to action being thereby stifled. Every- thing in this essay is prophetic: the proximity of the return of the Greek spirit, the necessity for counter Alexanders to retie the Gordian knot of Greek culture after it had been untied... Listen to the world-historic accent with which the concept 52 THE BIRTH OF *tragic disposition* is introduced: there are in this essay nothing but world-historic accents. This is the strangest 'objectivity' there can be: the absolute certainty of what I am projected itself *Oil* to any reality that chanced to appear - the truth about myself spoke out of a dreadful depth. The style of Zarathustra is described and anticipated with incisive certainty; and one will find nowhere a more magnificent expression for the Zarathustra event, the act of a tremendous purification and dedication of mankind. THE UNTIMELY ESSAYS The four untimely essays are altogether warlike. They demonstrate that I was no 'Jack o' Dreams', that I derive pleasure from drawing the sword - also, perhaps, that I have a dangerously supple wrist. The first attack (1873) was on German culture, which even at that time I already looked down on with remorseless contempt. Without meaning, without substance, without aim: a mere 'public opinion'. There is no more vicious misunderstanding than to believe that the Germans' great success in arms could demonstrate anything in favour of this culture - not to speak of its victory over France. The second untimely essay (1874) brings to light what is dangerous, what gnaws at and poisons life, in our way of carrying on science -: life sick with this inhuman clockwork and mechanism, with the 'personality' of the worker, with the false economy of 'division of labour'. The goal gets lost, culture - the means, the modern way of carrying on science, barbarized ... In this essay the 'historical sense' of which this century is so proud is recognized for the first time as a sickness, as a typical sign of decay. - In the third and fourth untimely essays two pictures of the sternest selfishness, self-discipline are erected against this, as signposts to a higher concept of culture, to the restoration of the concept 'culture': untimely types par excellence, full of sovereign contempt for all that around them which was called 'Reich', 'culture', 'Christianity', 'Bismarck', 'success' - Schopenhauer and Wagner or, in one word, Nietzsche 54 I. V ESSAYS Of these four attentats, the first enjoyed an extraordinary The noise it called forth was in every sense magnificent. I had touched a victorious nation on its sore spot that its victory was not a cultural event, but perhaps, perhaps something quite different... The reply came from all sides and by no means merely from old friends of David Strauss, whom I had rendered ludicrous as the type of a German culture-philistine and satisfied, in short as the author of an ale-house gospel of 'old faith and new' (- the

word culture-philistine [Bildungsphilister] has remained in the language from its employment in my essay). These old friends, whom as Wurtembergers and Swabians I had cut to the quick when I found their prodigy, their Strauss comical, replied as staunchly and uncouthly as I could possibly have wished; the Prussian retorts were cleverer - they had more 'Berlin blue' in them. The most indecent came from a Leipzig paper, the infamous 'Grenzboten'; I had trouble restraining the enraged Basellers from taking steps against it. The only people unconditionally on my side were a number of elderly gentlemen and their motives were mixed and in part undiscoverable. Among them Ewald of Gottingen, who gave it out that my attentat had proved fatal to Strauss. Likewise the old Hegelian Bruno Bauer, in whom I have from then on had one of my most attentive readers. In his last years he liked to refer for example Heinrich von Treitschke, the Prussian historian, to me for a hint as to where he might find information about the concept 'culture' which he had lost hold of. The most thoughtful, also the longest commentary on the essay and its author was uttered by a former pupil of the philosopher von Baader, a Professor Hoffmann of Wiirzburg. He foresaw from this essay a great vocation for me - to bring about a kind of crisis and supreme decision in the problem of atheism, the most instinctive and ruthless advocate of which he divined me to be. It was atheism which led me to Schopenhauer. - By far the best heard and most bitterly felt reaction was an extraordinarily strong and courageous defence by the usually so moderate Karl Hillebrand, that last humane German who knew how to wield the pen. His essay appeared in the 'Augsburger Zeitung'; it is included in a somewhat more cautious form in his collected writings. Here my essay was represented as an event, a turning-point, a first calling of oneself to order, as the best of all signs, as a real return of German seriousness and German passion in spiritual things. Hillebrand was full of high regard for the form of the essay, for its mature taste, for its perfect tact in distinguishing between the person and the matter at issue: he designated it the finest polemical writing to be written in German - in the art of polemics so dangerous and inadvisable for Germans. Unconditionally affirmative, even more severe than I had ventured to be on the ruination of language going on in Germany (- today they play the purist and can no longer construct a sentence -), equally contemptuous of the 'leading writers' of this nation, he ended by expressing his admiration for my courage - that 'supreme courage which calls the favourites of a nation to account'.. . The after-effect of this essay has been downright inestimable in my life. Up to now no one has sought to quarrel with me. One keeps silent, one treats me in Germany with a gloomy caution: I have for years employed an unconditional freedom of speech for which no one today, least of all in Germany, has his hand sufficiently free. My paradise is 'beneath the shadow of my sword'.. . What I really did was to put into practice a maxim of Stendhal's: he advised one to make

one's entry into society with a duel. And how well I had chosen my opponent! the foremost German freethinker! ... In fact it was a quite new kind of freethinking which therewith first found expression: to the present day there is nothing more foreign or unrelated to me than the entire European and American species of Uibres penseurs\ I even feel myself more deeply divided from these incorrigible shallow-pates and buffoons of 'modern ideas' than I do from any of their opponents. They too want in their own way to 'improve' mankind, after their image, they would wage an implacable war against what I am, what I want, if they 56 fHE UNTIMELY ESSAYS understood it they one and all still believe in the 'ideal' ... I am the first im moralist 3 That the untimely essays designated with the names Schopen- hauer and Wagner could contribute very greatly to an understanding of these two cases, or even to the posing of psychological questions about them, I would not like to assert - a few things in them of course excepted. Thus, for example, what is elemental in Wagner's nature is even here with profound cer- tainty of instinct designated as an actor's talent the methods and objectives of which are only consequences of it. What I really wanted to do in these essays was something quite other than to pursue psychology - a problem of education without its like, a new concept of self-discipline, self-defence to the point of harshness, a way to greatness and to world-historical tasks demanded its first expression. What I did by and large was to take two famous and still altogether undetermined types by the forelock, as one takes an opportunity by the forelock, in order to say something, in order to have a couple more formulas, signs, means of expression in my hands. This is, with perfectly uncanny sagacity, even indicated in the third untimely essay. It was in this way that Plato employed Socrates, as a semiotic for Plato. - Now, when I look back from a distance at the circumstances of which these essays are a witness, I would not wish to deny that fundamentally they speak only of me. The essay 'Wagner in Bayreuth' is a vision of my future; on the other hand, in 'Schopenhauer as Educator' it is my innermost history, my evolution that is inscribed. Above all my solemn vow\.. . What I am today, where I am today - at a height at which I no longer speak with words but with lightning-bolts - oh how far away I was from it in those days! - But I saw the land - I did not deceive myself for a moment as to the way, sea, danger - and success! Great repose in promising, this happy looking outward into a future which shall not always remain a promise! 57 ECCE HOMO - Here every word is experienced, profound, inward; the most painful things are not lacking, there are words in it which are downright bloodsoaked. But a wind of the great freedom blows across everything; the wound itself does not act as an objection. - How I understand the philosopher, as a fearful explosive material from which everything is in danger, how I remove my concept 'philosopher' miles away from a concept which includes in it even a Kant, not to speak of the academic 'ruminants' and other professors of philosophy: as to this the essay offers an

invaluable instruction, even admitting that what is being spoken of is fundamentally not 'Schopenhauer as Educator' but his opposite, 'Nietzsche as Educator'. — Considering that my trade was at this time that of a scholar, and perhaps too that I understood my trade, an astringent piece of psychology of the scholar which suddenly appears in this essay is not without significance: it expresses feeling of distance, my profound certainty as to what can be my task and what merely means, interlude and extra. It is my sagacity to have been many things and in many places so as to be able to become one person - so as to be able to attain one thing. For a time I had also to be a scholar. - HUMAN, ALL TOO HUMAN With Two Supplements 'Human, All Too Human' is the memorial of a crisis. It calls itself a book for free spirits: almost every sentence in it is the expression of a victory - with this book I liberated myself from that in my nature which did not belong to me. Idealism does not belong to me: the title says: *where you see ideal things, I see - human, alas all too human things!' ... I know humanity better.. . The expression 'free spirit' should here be understood in no other sense: a spirit that has become free, that has again seized possession of itself. The tone, the sound of the voice has completely changed: one will find the book sagacious, cool, sometimes harsh and mocking. A certain spirituality of noble taste seems to be in constant struggle to keep itself aloft above a more passionate current running underneath. In this connection there is significance in the fact that it is actually the hundredth anniversary of the death of Voltaire with which the book as it were apologizes for being published in Voltaire is, in contrast to all who have written after him, above all a grandseigneur of the spirit: precisely what I am too. - The name of Voltaire on a writing by me - that really was progress - towards myself ... If one looks more closely, one discovers a merciless spirit who knows every hiding-place in which the ideal is at home - where it has its castle-keep and as it were its last place of security. With a torch in hand which gives no trembling light I illuminate with piercing brightness this underworld of the ideal. It is a war, but a war without powder and smoke, without warlike attitudes, without pathos and contorted limbs - all this would still have been 'idealism'. One error after 59 ECCE HOMO another is calmly laid on ice, the ideal is not refuted - it freezes.. . Here for example 'the genius' freezes; on the next corner 'the saint' freezes; 'the hero' freezes into a thick icicle; at last 'faith', so-called 'conviction', freezes; 'pity' also grows considerably cooler - almost everywhere 'the thing in itself' freezes The beginnings of this book belong within the weeks of the first Bayreuth Festival; a profound estrangement from all that surrounded me there is one of its preconditions. Anyone who has any idea what visions had been flitting across my path even at that time can guess how I felt when I one day came to myself in Bayreuth. It was as if I had been dreaming . Where was I? I recognized nothing, I hardly recognized Wagner. In vain I scanned my memories. Tribschen - a distant isle of the blessed: not the

shadow of a resemblance. The incomparable days of the foundation-stone laying, the little band of initiates who celebrated them and who did not lack fingers for delicate things: not the shadow of a resemblance. What had happened} - Wagner had been translated into German! The Wagnerian had become master of Wagner! - German art! The German master! German beer!... We others, who know only too well to how refined a species of artists, to how cosmopolitan a taste Wagner's art alone speaks, were beside ourselves to rediscover Wagner bedecked with German 'virtue'. - I think I know the Wagnerian, I have 'experienced' three generations of them, from the late Brendel, who confused Wagner with Hegel, to the 'idealists' of the Bayreuther Blätter, who confuse Wagner with themselves - I have heard every kind of confession about Wagner from 'beautiful souls'. A kingdom for one sensible word! - Truly, a hair-raising crowd! Nohl, Pohl, Kohl charmingly in infinitum! Not an abortion was missing, not even the anti-Semite. - Poor Wagner! To what a pass had he come! - Better for him to have gone among swine! But among Germans! . For the instruction of posterity a genuine Bayreuther ought in the end to be 60 Ill MAN, ALL TOO HI'MAN Stuffed, better still preserved in spirit, for spirit is what is lacking with the inscription: this is what the 'spirit' was like upon which the 'Reich' was founded . Enough, I left in the midst of this for a couple of weeks, very suddenly, even though a charming Parisienne tried to console me; I excused myself to Wagner merely with a fatalistic telegram. At a place deeply buried in the Bohemian Forest, Klingenbrunn, I bore my melancholy and contempt for Germans about with me like an illness - and wrote a sentence in my pocket-book from time to time under the general title 'The Ploughshare', nothing but hard psychologica which can perhaps still be rediscovered in 'Human, All Too Human*'. 3 What then resolved itself within me was not merely a breach with Wagner - I sensed a total aberration of my instinct of which the individual blunder, call it Wagner or my professorship at Basel, was merely a sign. I was overcome with impatience at myself; I realized it was high time for me to think back to myself. It became of a sudden terribly clear to me how much time I had already squandered - how useless, how capricious my whole philologist's existence appeared when compared with my task. I was ashamed of this false modesty . Ten years behind me during which the nourishment of my spirit had quite literally been at a stop, during which I had learned nothing useful, during which I had forgotten inordinately much over a trash of dusty scholarship. Creeping meticulously and with bad eyesight through antique metrists - that is what I had come to! - I was moved to compassion when I saw myself quite thin, quite wasted away: realities were altogether lacking in my knowledge, and the 'idealities' were worth damn all! - A downright burning thirst seized hold of me: thenceforward I pursued in fact nothing other than physiology, medicine and natural science - I returned to actual historical studies only when the task imperiously compelled me to. It was

then too that I first 61 ECCE HOMO divined the connection between an activity chosen contrary to one's instincts, a so-called 'calling' to which one is called least of all - and that need for a stupefaction of the feeling of emptiness and hunger through a narcotic art - for example through Wagnerian art. A more careful survey has revealed to me that a large number of young men are in a like predicament: one piece of anti-nature downright compels a second. In Germany, in the 'Reich', to speak without ambiguity, all too many are condemned to decide too soon and then to sicken away beneath a burden they find they cannot throw off. Such people desire Wagner as an opiate - they forget themselves, they are free of themselves for a moment.. What am I saying? for five or six hours! - At that time my instinct decided inexorably against any further giving way, going along, confounding of myself with what I was not. Any kind of life, the most unfavourable conditions, sickness, poverty - all seemed preferable to that unworthy 'selflessness' into which I had first got out of ignorance, out of youth, in which I had subsequently remained out of lethargy, out of so-called 'sense of duty'. - Here there came to my aid, in a way I cannot sufficiently admire and at precisely the right time, that bad inheritance from my father's side - fundamentally a predestination to an early death. Sickness liberated me slowly, it spared me any kind of breach, any violent or offensive step. I forfeited no goodwill at that time and gained much. Sickness likewise gave me a right to a complete reversal of my habits; it permitted, it commanded forgetting; it bestowed on me the compulsion to lie still, to be idle, to wait and be patient. But to do that means to think! My eyes alone put an end to all bookwormishness, in plain terms philology: I was redeemed from the 'book', for years at a time I read nothing - the greatest favour I have ever done myself! - That deepest self, as it were buried and grown silent under a constant compulsion to listen to 62 ILL MAN, ALL TOO IN MAN other selves (and that is what reading means!) awoke slowly, timidly, doubtfully but at length it spoke again. I have never been so happy with myself as in the sickest and most painful periods of my life: one has only to look at 'Daybreak' or perhaps the 'Wanderer and his Shadow' to grasp what this 'return to myself was: a highest kind of recovery itself!.. The other kind merely followed from this. - 5 Human, All Too Human, this memorial of a rigorous self-discipline with which I made a sudden end of every sort of 'higher swindle', 'idealism', 'beautiful feelings' and other womanishnesses that I had been infected with, was written chiefly in Sorrento; it received its conclusion, its final form during a Basel winter under far less favourable conditions than those in Sorrento. It is really Herr Peter Gasty then studying in Basel and very attached to me, who has the book on his conscience. I dictated, my head bandaged and painful, he wrote, he also corrected - he was really the actual writer, while I was merely the author. When the book finally arrived finished into my hands - to the profound astonishment of a serious invalid - I sent among

others two copies to Bayreuth. Through a miracle of meaningful chance I received at the same time a beautiful copy of the Parsifal text, with Wagner's dedication to me, 'his dear friend Friedrich Nietzsche, Richard Wagner, Ecclesiastical Counsellor'. - This crossing of the two books - it seemed to me to make an ominous sound. Was it not as though two swords had crossed? ... At least we both felt it to be so: for we both kept silent. - About this time the first Bayreuther Blatter appeared: I grasped for what it had been high time. - Incredible! Wagner had become pious What I thought about myself at that time (1876), with what tremendous certainty I held in my hands my task and what was 65 ECCE HOMO world-historic in it, the whole book, but especially a very explicit passage, bears witness: except that, with my instinctive cunning, I here too avoided the little word T, and this time it was not Schopenhauer or Wagner but one of my friends, the excellent Dr Paul Ree, whom I bathed in world-historic glory - who was happily far too refined a creature to . Others were less refined: I have always recognized the hopeless cases among my readers, the typical German professor for example, in that they have on the basis of this passage believed themselves compelled to understand the whole book as higher realism In fact it contains a contradiction of five or six propositions of my friend: a point discussed in the preface to the 'Genealogy of Morals'. - The passage reads: But what is the main proposition arrived at by one of the boldest and coldest of thinkers, the author of the book 'On the Origin of the Moral Sensations' (Nietzsche, the first immoralist), by virtue of his incisive and penetrating analysis of human behaviour? 'Moral man is no closer to the intelligible world than physical man -for there is no intelligible world.. .' This proposition, hardened and sharpened beneath the hammer-blow of historical knowledge (Nietzsche's Revaluation of All Values), may perhaps at some future time - 1890! - serve as the axe which is laid at the root of the 'metaphysical need' of man - whether more of a blessing or a curse to mankind who could say? But in any event as a proposition with the weightiest consequences, at once fruitful and fearful and looking out at the world with the Janus-face possessed by all great perceptions... DAYBREAK Thoughts about Morality as a Prejudice With this book begins my campaign against morality. Not that it smells in the slightest of gunpowder - quite other and more pleasant odours will be perceived in it, provided one has some subtlety in one's nostrils. Neither big nor even small guns: if the effect of the book is negative, its means are all the less so, means from which the effect follows like a conclusion not like a cannon-shot. That one takes leave of the book with a cautious reserve in regard to everything that has hitherto been honoured and even worshipped under the name morality does not contradict the fact that in the entire book there is no negative word, no attack, no malice - that it rather lies in the sun, round, happy, like a sea-beast sunning itself among rocks. In the end it was I myself who was this sea-beast: almost

every sentence in the book was thought, tracked down among that confusion of rocks near to Genoa where I was alone and still shared secrets with the sea. Even now, when I chance to light on this book every sentence becomes for me a spike with which I again draw something incomparable out of the depths: its entire skin trembles with tender shudders of recollection. The art in which it is preeminent is no small one in making things which easily slip by without a sound, moments which I call divine lizards, stay still for a little - not with the cruelty of that young Greek god who simply impaled the poor little lizard, but none the less still with something sharp, with the pen . 'There are so many daybreaks that have not yet dawned' - this Indian inscription stands on the gateway to this book. Where does its author seek that new dawn, that hitherto still undetected tender roseate sky 65 ECCE HOMO with which another day ah, a whole series, a whole world of new days! - breaks? In a revaluation of all values, in an escape from all moral values, in an affirmation of and trust in all that has hitherto been forbidden, despised, accursed. This affirmative book pours its light, its love, its tenderness upon nothing but evil things, it restores to them their 'soul', the good conscience, the exalted right and privilege to exist. Morality is not attacked, it only no longer comes into consideration . This book ends with an 'Or?' - it is the only book which ends with an 'Or?' My task, to prepare a moment of supreme coming-to-oneself on the part of mankind, a great noontide when it looks back and looks forward, when it steps out from the dominion of chance and the priesthood and poses the question why? to what end? for the first time as a whole - this task follows of necessity from the insight that mankind is not of itself on the right path, that it is absolutely not divinely directed, that under precisely its holiest value-concepts rather the instinct of denial, of decay, the decadence instinct has seductively ruled. The question of the origin of moral values is therefore for me a question of the, first rank because it conditions the future of mankind. The demand that one ought to believe that fundamentally everything is in the best hands, that a book, the Bible, will set one's mind finally at rest as to divine governance and wisdom in the destiny of mankind, is translated back into reality, the will to suppress the truth as to the pitiable opposite of this, namely that hitherto mankind has been in the worst hands, that it has been directed by the under-privileged, the cunningly revengeful, the so-called 'saints', those world-calumniators and desecraters of man. The decisive sign that reveals that the priest (- including the concealed priest, the philosopher) has become master not only within a certain religious community but in general is that decadence morality, the will to the end, counts as morality in itself, is the unconditional value everywhere accorded to the unegoistic and 66 DAVISK I \ K the hostility accorded the egoistic. Whoever does not Agree with me on this point I consider infected... But the whole world does not agree with me For a physiologist such a value-antithesis admits of no dubiety. When within an

organism the meanest organ neglects even to the slightest degree to assert with absolute certainty its self-preservation, indemnity for its expenditure of force, its 'egoism', the whole degenerates. The physiologist demands excision of the degenerate part, he denies any solidarity with it, he is far from pitying it. But the priest wants precisely the degeneration of the whole, of mankind: that is why he conserves the degenerate part - at this price he dominates mankind.. . What is the purpose of those lying concepts, the ancillary concepts of morality 'soul', 'spirit', 'free will', 'God', if it is not the physiological ruination of mankind? . When one directs seriousness away from self-preservation, enhancement of bodily strength, when one makes of greensick- ness an ideal, of contempt for the body 'salvation of the soul', what else is it but a recipe for decadence? - Loss of centre of gravity, resistance to the natural instincts, in a word 'selfless- ness' - that has hitherto been called morality . With 'Daybreak' I first took up the struggle against the morality of unselfing. - THE GAY SCIENCE 'Daybreak' is an affirmative book, profound but bright and benevolent. The same applies once again and in the highest degree to the gaya scien^a: in practically every sentence of this book profundity and exuberance go hand in hand. A poem which expresses gratitude for the most wonderful month of January I have ever experienced - the entire book is a gift - betrays out of what a depth 'science' has here become gay: You who with your spear of fire Melt the river of my soul, So that, freed from ice, it rushes Toward the ocean of its goal: Brighter still and still more healthy, Free in most desired constraint - Thus your miracle it praises, January, lovely saint! As to what is here called 'goal' - who can be in any doubt as to what this means who sees glittering at the conclusion of the fourth book the diamond beauty of the opening words of Zarathustra? - Or who reads at the end of the third book the granite sentences with which a destiny for all ages formulates itself for the first time. - Songs of Prince Vogelfrei, composed for the most part in Sicily, call to mind quite explicitly the Provençal concept of 'gaya scien^a' that union of minstrel, knight and free-spirit by which that marvellous early culture of the Provençals is distinguished from all ambiguous cultures; the last poem of all especially, 'to the Mistral \ an exuberant dance- song in which, if I may say so! I dance right over morality, is a perfect Provençalism. - 68 THUS SPOKE ZARATHUSTRA A Book for Everyone and No One I shall now tell the story of Zarathustra. The basic conception of the work, the idea of eternal recurrence, the highest formula of affirmation that can possibly be attained - belongs to the August of the year 1881: it was jotted down on a piece of paper with the inscription: '6,000 feet beyond man and time'. I was that day walking through the woods beside the lake of Silva- plana; I stopped beside a mighty pyramidal block of stone which reared itself up not far from Surlei. Then this idea came to me. - If I reckon a couple of months back from this day I find as an omen a sudden and profoundly decisive alteration in my taste, above all in music. The whole of Zarathustra might

perhaps be reckoned as music; - certainly a rebirth of the art of hearing was a precondition of it. In a little mountain resort not far from Vicenza, Recoaro, where I spent the spring of the year 1881, I discovered together with my maestro and friend Peter Gast, who was likewise 'reborn', that the phoenix music flew past us with lighter and more luminous wings than it had ever exhibited before. If on the other hand I reckon from that day forwards to the sudden delivery accomplished under the most improbable circumstances in February 1883 - the closing section, from which I have quoted a couple of sentences in the Foreword, was completed precisely at that sacred hour when Richard Wagner died in Venice - the pregnancy is seen to have lasted eighteen months. This term of precisely eighteen months might suggest, at least to Buddhists, that I am really a female elephant. - The interval is occupied by the 'gaya scienza' which bears a hundred signs of the proximity of something incomparable; & [^]* ECCE HOMO finally it gives the opening of Zarathustra itself, it gives in the penultimate piece of the fourth book the fundamental idea of Zarathustra. - Also belonging to this interval is that Hymn to Life (for mixed chorus and orchestra) the score of which was published two years ago by E. W. Fritzsche of Leipzig: a perhaps not insignificant symptom of the condition of this year, when I was possessed to the highest degree by the affirmative pathos par excellence [^] which I call the tragic pathos. It will one day be sung to my memory. - The text, I may state expressly because a misunderstanding exists about it, is not by me: it is the astonishing inspiration of a young Russian lady with whom I was then friendly, Fraulein Lou von Salome. He who knows how to extract any meaning at all from the closing words of the poem will divine why I preferred and admired it: they possess greatness. Pain does not count as an objection to life: 'Have you no more happiness to give me, well then! still do you have your pain.. .' Perhaps my music is also great at this point, [last note of the clarinet in A is C sharp not C. Printing error.] - I lived the following winter in the pleasantly quiet bay of Rapallo not far from Genoa which cuts in between Chiavari and the promontory of Porto Fino. My health was not of the best; the winter cold and exceedingly wet; a small albergo situated right against the sea, so that at night the high tide made sleep impossible, offered all in all the very opposite of what one might desire. In spite of this, and almost as a proof of my proposition that everything decisive comes about 'in spite of', it was during this winter and under these unfavourable conditions that my Zarathustra came into existence. - In the mornings I climbed in a southerly direction into the heights along the glorious route to Zoagli, past pine-trees and with a vast view of the sea; in the afternoons, whenever my health permitted I walked around the entire bay from Santa Margherita to Porto Fino. This place and this landscape is even closer to my heart through the great love Kaiser Friedrich the Third felt for it; in the autumn of 1886 I happened to be on this coast again when he visited this little forgotten

world of happiness for the last time. - It was on these 70 THUS SPOKE / ARATIIIIISTRA two walks that the whole of the first Zarathustra came to me, above all Zarathustra himself, as a type: more accurately, he stole up on me... To understand this type one has first to become clear as to its physiological presupposition: it is that which I call great health. I do not know how to illustrate this conception better or more personally than I have already done in one of the last sections of the fifth book of the 'gaya scien%a\ 'We new, name- less, ill-understood' - it says there - 'we premature-born of a yet undemonstrated future, we need for a new goal also a new means, namely a new health, a stronger, shrewder, tougher, more daring, more cheerful health than any has been hitherto. He whose soul thirsts to have experienced the whole compass of values and desiderata and to have sailed around every coast of this "Middle Sea" of ideals, who wants to know from the adventures of his own most personal experience how a conqueror and discoverer of the ideal feels, likewise how an artist, a saint, a lawgiver, a sage, a scholar, a man of piety, a divine hermit of the old stamp feels: he needs one thing before all else, great health - a health such as one does not merely have but has continually to win because one has again and again to sacrifice it... And now, after having been thus under way for a long time, we Argonauts of the ideal, braver perhaps than is prudent and often enough shipwrecked and come to grief but, as said, healthier than others would like us to be, dangerously healthy, healthy again and again - it seems to us as if we have, as a reward, a yet undiscovered country before us whose boundaries none has ever seen, a land beyond all known lands and corners of the ideal, a world so overfull of the beautiful, strange, questionable, terrible and divine that our curiosity and our thirst for possession are both beside themselves so that nothing can any longer satisfy us! ... How, after such prospects and with such a ravenous hunger in conscience and knowledge, 7i ECCE HOMO could we remain content with the man of the present? It is hard enough to remain serious when we regard his worthiest hopes and objectives, and perhaps we do not even regard them any more... Another ideal runs ahead of us, a strange, seductive, dangerous ideal to which we do not want to convert anyone because we do not easily admit that anyone has a right to it: the ideal of a spirit who naively, that is to say impulsively and from overflowing plenitude and power, plays with everything hither- to called holy, good, untouchable, divine; for whom the highest things by which the people reasonably enough take their stand- ards would signify something like a danger, a corruption, a degradation, or at least a recreation, a blindness, a temporary self-forgetfulness; the ideal of a human-super-human well-being and well-wishing which will often enough seem inhuman, for example when it is set beside the whole of earthly seriousness hitherto, beside every kind of solemnity in gesture, word, tone, glance, morality and task as their most corporal involuntary parody - and with which, in spite of all that, perhaps

the great seriousness first arises, the real question-mark is first set up, the destiny of the soul veers round, the clock-hand moves on, the tragedy begins.. ' 3 — Has anyone at the end of the nineteenth century a distinct conception of what poets of strong ages called inspiration? If not, I will describe it. - If one had the slightest residue of superstition left in one, one would hardly be able to set aside the idea that one is merely incarnation, merely mouthpiece, merely medium of overwhelming forces. The concept of revelation, in the sense that something suddenly, with unspeakable certainty and subtlety, becomes visible, audible, something that shakes and overturns one to the depths, simply describes the fact. One hears, one does not seek; one takes, one does not ask who gives; a thought flashes up like lightning, with necessity, unfalteringly formed - I have never had any choice. An ecstasy 72 Tills SPOK I /AH A I Ills IRA whose tremendous tension sometimes discharges it sc-It m s flood of tears, while one's steps now involuntarily rush along, now involuntarily lag; a complete being outside of oneself with the distinct consciousness of a multitude of subtle shudders and trickles down to one's toes; a depth of happiness in which the most painful and gloomy things appear, not as an antithesis, but as conditioned, demanded, as a necessary colour within such a superfluity of light; an instinct for rhythmical relationships which spans forms of wide extent - length, the need for a wide-spanned rhythm is almost the measure of the force of inspiration, a kind of compensation for its pressure and tension . Every- thing is in the highest degree involuntary but takes place as in a tempest of a feeling of freedom, of absoluteness, of power, of divinity.. . The involuntary nature of image, of metaphor is the most remarkable thing of all; one no longer has any idea what is image, what metaphor, everything presents itself as the readiest, the truest, the simplest means of expression. It really does seem, to allude to a saying of Zarathustra's, as if the things themselves approached and offered themselves as metaphors (- 'here all things come caressingly to your discourse and flatter you: for they want to ride upon your back. Upon every image you here ride to every truth. Here, the words and word- chests of all existence spring open to you; all existence here wants to become words, all becoming here wants to learn speech from you -'). This is my experience of inspiration; I do not doubt that one has to go back thousands of years to find anyone who could say to me 'it is mine also'. - I lay ill for a couple of weeks in Genoa. There followed a melancholy spring in Rome, where I merely put up with life - it was not easy. This place, the most improper in the world for the poet of Zarathustra and which I had not chosen voluntarily, vexed me beyond measure; I tried to get away - I wanted to go to Aquila, the counter-concept to Rome, founded out of enmity 73 ECCE HOMO towards Rome, as I shall one day found a place to the memory of an atheist and enemy of the church comme il faut, to one who is most closely related to me, the great Hohenstaufen emperor Friedrich the Second. But a fatality hung over it all:

I had to return. I finally acquiesced in the piasga Barberini after I had grown weary of trying to find an anti-Christian quarter. I am afraid that once, in an effort to escape the bad odours as much as possible, I asked at the palaio del Quirinale itself whether they did not have a quiet room for a philosopher. - On a loggia high above the said piaaa, from which one has a view across Rome and deep beneath the rustling of the fontana can be heard, that loneliest song was written that ever was written, the Night Song; at this time a melody of unspeakable melancholy went on continually around me whose refrain I rediscovered in the words 'dead of immortality'. In the summer, returned home to the sacred spot where the first lightning of the Zarathustra idea had flashed to me, I found the second Zarathustra. Ten days sufficed; in no case, neither with the first nor with the third and last did I require more. The following winter, beneath the halcyon sky of Nice, which then shone into my life for the first time, I found the third Zarathustra - and was done. The whole took hardly a year. Many hidden places and heights in the landscape of Nice are for me consecrated by unforgettable moments; that decisive chapter which bears the title 'Of Old and New Law-Tables' was composed during the most painful climb from the station to the marvellous Moorish hill castle Eza - my muscular agility has always been greatest when my creative power has flowed most abundantly. The body is inspired: let us leave the 'soul' out of it ... I could often have been seen dancing; at that time I could walk for seven or eight hours in the mountains without a trace of tiredness. I slept well, I laughed a lot - I was perfectly vigorous and perfectly patient. 5 Apart from these ten-day works the years during and above all after Zarathustra were a state of distress without equal. One 74 THUS SPOkh ZAK A I III S IK A pays dearly for being immortal: one has to die several times while alive. - There is something I call the rancune of what is great: everything great, a work, a deed, once it is completed forthwith turns against him who did it. Precisely because he did it he is from then on weak - he can no longer endure his deed, he can no longer look it in the face. To have something behind one that one ought never to have willed, something within which the knot of destiny of mankind is tied - and from then on to have it to wone! . . . It almost crushes. . . The rancune of what is great! - A second thing is the horrible silence one hears around one. Solitude has seven skins; nothing can get through them. One encounters people, one greets friends: new desolation, no glance offers a greeting. At best a kind of revolt. I experienced such a revolt, in very varying degrees but from almost everyone who was close to me; it seems that nothing gives greater offence than suddenly to let a distance become perceptible - noble natures who do not know how to live without venerating are rare. - A third thing is the absurd susceptibility of the skin to pinpricks, a kind of helplessness in the face of everything small. This seems to me to be conditioned by the tremendous expenditure of all defensive energies presupposed by every creative deed, every

deed that comes from the most personal, innermost, deepest part of one's being. The minor defensive capabilities are thereby as it were suspended; they no longer receive any energy. - I also venture to suggest that one digests less well, prefers not to move, is all too vulnerable to feeling cold as well as mistrust - mistrust which is in many cases merely an etiological error. While in such a condition I once sensed the proximity of a herd of cows even before I saw them through the return of milder, more philanthropic thoughts: that had warmth in it This work stands altogether alone. Let us leave the poets aside: perhaps nothing at all has ever been done out of a like superflu- ity of strength. My concept 'dionysian' has here become the supreme deed\ compared with it all the rest of human activity 75 ECCE HOMO seems poor and conditional. That a Goethe, a Shakespeare would not for a moment have known how to breathe in this tremendous passion and solitude, that Dante is, compared with Zarathustra, merely a believer and not one who first creates truth, a world-ruling spirit, a destiny - that the poets of the Veda are priests and not even worthy to unloose the latchet of the shoes of a Zarathustra - all this is the least of it, and gives no idea of the distance, of the a^ure solitude, in which this work lives. Zarathustra has an eternal right to say: 'I form circles and holy boundaries around myself; fewer and fewer climb with me upon higher and higher mountains - I build a mountain range out of holier and holier mountains.' Reckon into a single sum the spirit and goodness of all great souls: all of them together would not be capable of producing one of Zarathustra's discourses. The ladder upon which he climbs up and down is tremendous; he has seen further, willed further, been able further than any other human being. He contradicts with every word, this most affirmative of all spirits; all opposites are in him bound together into a new unity. The highest and the lowest forces of human nature, the sweetest, most frivolous and most fearsome stream forth out of one fountain with immortal certainty. Until then one does not know what height, what depth is; one knows even less what truth is. There is no moment in this revelation of truth which would have been anticipated or divined by even one of the greatest. There is no wisdom, no psychology, no art of speech before Zarathustra: the nearest things, the most everyday things here speak of things unheard of. The aphorism trembling with passion; eloquence become music; lightning-bolts hurled ahead to hitherto undivined futures. The mightiest capacity for metaphor which has hitherto existed is poor and child's play compared with this return of language to the nature of imagery. - And how Zarathustra condescends and says the kindest things to everyone! How he takes even his opponents, the priests, with gentle hands and suffers from them with them! - Here man is overcome every moment, the concept 'superman' here becomes the greatest reality - all that has hitherto been called great in man lies at an infinite distance beneath it. The halcyon, light feet, the ubiquity of wickedness and 76 THUS SPOKE ZARATHUSTRA exuberance and whatever else is typical of

the type Zarathustra has never been dreamed of as essential to greatness. It is in precisely this compass of space, in this access to opposites that Zarathustra feels himself to be the highest species of all existing things, and when one hears how he defines this one will refrain from seeking what is like him. - the soul which possesses the longest ladder and can descend the deepest, the most spacious soul, which can run and stray and roam the farthest into itself, the most necessary soul, which out of joy hurls itself into chance, the existing soul which plunges into becoming, the possessing soul which wants to partake in desire and longing - the soul fleeing from itself which retrieves itself in the widest sphere, the wisest soul, to which foolishness speaks sweetest, the soul that loves itself the most, in which all things have their current and counter-current and ebb and flow - But that is the concept of Dionysos himself. — Another consideration leads to the same conclusion. The psychological problem in the type of Zarathustra is how he, who to an unheard-of degree says No, does No to everything to which one has hitherto said Yes, can none the less be the opposite of a spirit of denial; how he, a spirit bearing the heaviest of destinies, a fatality of a task, can none the less be the lightest and most opposite - Zarathustra is a dancer - : how he, who has the harshest, the most fearful insight into reality, who has thought the 'most abysmal thought', none the less finds in it no objection to existence, nor even to the eternal recurrence of existence - rather one more reason to be himself the eternal Yes to all things, 'the tremendous unbounded Yes and Amen' 'Into every abyss I still bear the blessing of my affirmation'.. . But that is the concept of Dionysos once more. 11 ECCE HOMO 7 - What language will such a spirit speak when he speaks with himself alone? The language of the dithyramb. I am the inventor of the dithyramb. Hear how Zarathustra speaks with himself before sunrise: such an emerald happiness, such a divine tenderness still had no tongue before me. Even the deepest melancholy of such a Dionysos still becomes a dithyramb; I take, as an indication, the Night Song - the immortal lament that through his superabundance of light and power, through his nature as a sun, he is condemned not to love. It is night: now do all leaping fountains speak louder. And my soul too is a leaping fountain. It is night: only now do all songs of lovers awaken. And my soul too is the song of a lover. Something unquenched, unquenchable is in me, that wants to speak out. A craving for love is in me that itself speaks the language of love. Light am I: ah, that I were night! But this is my solitude, that I am girded round with light. Ah, that I were dark and obscure! How I would suck at the breasts of light! And I should bless you, you little sparkling stars and glow-worms above! - and be happy in your gifts of light. But I live in my own light, I drink back into myself the flames that break from me. I do not know the joy of the receiver; and I have often dreamed that stealing must be more blessed than receiving. It is my poverty that my hand never rests from giving; it is my envy that I see expectant eyes and illumined nights of desire. Oh

wretchedness of all givers! Oh eclipse of my sun! Oh craving for desire! Oh ravenous hunger in satiety! They take from me: but do I yet touch their souls? A gulf IH is SPOKE / AK A Mills IRA stands between giving and receiving; and the smallest gulf must be bridged at last. A hunger grows from out of my beauty: I should like to rob those to whom I give - thus do I hunger after wickedness. Withdrawing my hand when another hand already reaches out to it; hesitating, like the waterfall that hesitates even in its plunge - thus do I hunger after wickedness. Such vengeance does my abundance concoct: such spite wells from my solitude. My joy in giving died in giving, my virtue grew weary of itself through its abundance! The danger for him who always gives is that he may lose his shame; the hand and heart of him who distributes grow callous through sheer distributing. My eye no longer overflows with the shame of suppliants; my hand has become too hard for the trembling of hands that have been filled. Where have the tears of my eye and the bloom of my heart gone? Oh solitude of all givers! Oh silence of all light- givers! Many suns circle in empty space: to all that is dark they speak with their light — to me they are silent. Oh, this is the enmity of light towards what gives light: unpitying it travels its way. Unjust towards the light-giver in its inmost heart, cold towards suns - thus travels every sun. Like a storm the suns fly along their courses; that is their travelling. They follow their inexorable will; that is their cold- ness. Oh, it is only you, obscure, dark ones, who extract warmth from light-givers! Oh, only you drink milk and comfort from the udders of light! Ah, ice is around me, my hand is burned with ice! Ah, thirst is in me, which yearns after your thirst! It is night: ah, that I must be light! And thirst for the things of night! And solitude! 79 ECCE HOMO It is night: now my longing breaks from me like a well- spring - I long for speech. It is night: now do all leaping fountains speak louder. And my soul too is a leaping fountain. It is night: only now do all songs of lovers awaken. And my soul too is the song of a lover. - 8 The like of this has never been written, never felt, never suffered: thus does a god suffer, a Dionysos. The reply to such a dithyramb of a sun's solitude in light would be Ariadne... Who knows except me what Ariadne is!... . Of all such riddles no one has hitherto had the solution, I doubt whether anyone even saw a riddle here. - On one occasion Zarathustra strictly defines his task - it is also mine - the meaning of which cannot be misunderstood: he is affirmative to the point of justifying, of redeeming even the entire past. I walk among men as among fragments of the future: of that future which I scan. And it is all my art and aim to compose into one and bring together what is fragment and riddle and dreadful chance. And how could I endure to be a man, if man were not also poet and reader of riddles and the redeemer of chance! To redeem the past and to transform every 'It was' into an 'I wanted it thus!' - that alone would I call redemption. In another place he defines as strictly as possible what alone 'man' can be for him - not an object of love, not to speak of pity - Zarathustra has also

mastered great disgust at man: to him man is formlessness, material, an ugly stone which requires the sculptor. No more to will and no more to evaluate and no more to create\ ah, that this great lassitude may ever stay far from me! In knowing and understanding, too, I feel only my will's 80 THUS SPOKE ZARATHUSTRA delight in begetting and becoming; and if there be innocence in my knowledge it is because will to begetting is in it. This will lured me away from God and gods; for what would there be to create if gods - existed! But again and again it drives me to mankind, my ardent, creative will; thus it drives the hammer to the stone. Ah you men, I see an image sleeping in the stone, the image of my visions! Ah, that it must sleep in the hardest, ugliest stone! Now my hammer rages fiercely against its prison. Fragments fly from the stone: what is that to me? I will complete it: for a shadow came to me - the most silent, the lightest of all things came to me! The beauty of the superman came to me as a shadow: what are the gods to me now! I emphasize one final point: the italicized line provides the occasion. Among the decisive preconditions for a dionysian task is the hardness of the hammer, joy even in destruction. The imperative 'become hard', the deepest certainty that all creators are hard, is the actual mark of a dionysian nature. - BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future The task for the immediately following years was as clear as it could be. Now that the affirmative part of my task was done, it was the turn of the denying, the No-saying and No-doing part: the revaluation of existing values themselves, the great war - the evocation of a day of decision. Included here is the slow search for those related to me, for such as out of strength would offer me their hand for the work of destruction. - From now on all my writings are fish-hooks: perhaps I understand fishing as well as anyone? ... If nothing got caught I am not to blame. There were no fish... This book (1886) is in all essentials a critique of modernity, the modern sciences, the modern arts, not even excluding modern politics, together with signposts to an antithetical type who is as little modern as possible, a noble, an affirmative type. In the latter sense the book is a school for gentlemen, that concept taken more spiritually and radically than it has ever been taken. One has to have courage in one even to endure it, one must never have learned fear.. . All the things of which the age is proud are felt as contradictions of this type, almost as bad manners, for example its celebrated 'objectivity', its 'sympathy with all that suffers', its 'historical sense' with its subjection to the taste of others, with its prostration before petits Juits, its 'scientific-ly'. - If one considers that the book comes after Zarathustra one will also perhaps divine the dietetic regime to which it owes 82 BLYND (,())! AND I- VII. its existence. The eye grown through a tremendous compulsion accustomed to seeing ajar - Zarathustra is more farsighted even than the Tsar - is here constrained to focus sharply on what is close at hand, the age, what is around us. In every aspect of the book, above all in its form, one will discover

the same intentional turning away from the instincts out of which a Zarathustra becomes possible. Refinement in form, in intention, in the art of keeping silent, is in the foreground, psychology is employed with an avowed harshness and cruelty - there is not a single good-natured word in the entire book. All this is recuperative: who could in the end divine what kind of recuperation is needed after such an expenditure of goodness as Zarathustra is? . Speaking theologically - pay heed, for I rarely speak as a theologian - it was God himself who at the end of his labour lay down as a serpent under the Tree of Knowledge: it was thus he recuperated from being God. He had made every- thing too beautiful.. . The Devil is merely the idleness of God on that seventh day ...

GENEALOGY OF MORALS A Polemic

The three essays of which this Genealogy consists are in regard to expression, intention and art of surprise perhaps the uncanniest things that have ever been written. Dionysos is, as one knows, also the god of darkness. - Each time a beginning which is intended to mislead, cool, scientific, even ironic, intentionally foreground, intentionally keeping in suspense. Gradually an increasing disquiet; isolated flashes of lightning; very unpleasant truths becoming audible as a dull rumbling in the distance - until at last a tempo feroce is attained in which everything surges forward with tremendous tension. At the conclusion each time amid perfectly awful detonations a new truth visible between thick clouds. - The truth of the first essay is the psychology of Christianity: the birth of Christianity out of the spirit of resentment, not, as is no doubt believed, out of the 'spirit' - essentially a counter-movement, the great revolt against the domination of noble values. The second essay gives the psychology of the conscience: it is not, as is no doubt believed, 'the voice of God in man' - it is the instinct of cruelty turned backwards after it can no longer discharge itself outwards. Cruelty here brought to light for the first time as one of the oldest substrata of culture and one that can least be thought away. The third essay gives the answer to the question where the tremendous power of the ascetic ideal, the priestly ideal, comes from, although it is the harmful ideal par excellence, a will to the end, a decadence ideal. Answer: not because God is active behind the priests, which is no doubt believed, but *faute de mieux* - because hitherto it has been the only ideal, because it had no competitors. 'For man will rather will nothingness than not will'.. . What was lacking above all was a counter-ideal - until the advent of Zarathustra. - I have been understood. Three

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decisive preliminary studies of a psychologist for a revaluation of all values. This book contains the first psychology of the priest.

TWILIGHT OF THE IDOLS

How to Philosophize with a Hammer This writing of fewer than 150 pages, cheerful and fateful in tone, a demon which laughs - the work of so few days I hesitate to reveal their number, is the exception among books: there exists nothing more rich in substance, more independent, more overthrowing - more wicked. If you want to get a quick idea

of how everything was upsidedown before me, make a start with this writing. That which is called idol on the title- page is quite simply that which has hitherto been called truth. Twilight of the Idols - in plain terms: the old truth is coming to an end... There is no reality, no 'ideality' which is not touched on in this writing (- touched on: what a cautious euphemism! .). Not merely eternal idols, also the youngest of all, consequently weakest with age. 'Modern ideas', for example. A great wind blows among the trees and everywhere fruits fall - truths. There is the prodigality of an all too abundant autumn in it: one trips over truths, one even treads some to death - there are too many of them.. . But those one gets one's hands on are no longer anything questionable, they are decisions. Only I have the standard for 'truths' in my hand, only I can decide. As if in me a second consciousness had grown, as if in me 'the will' had turned on a light for itself over the oblique path on which it had hitherto been descending.. . The oblique path - it was called the 'path to truth'... All 'obscure impulse' is at an end, it is 86 TWILIGHT OF THE IDOLS precisely the good man who has known least what was the right path.. . And, in all seriousness, no one before me has known the right path, the ascending path: only after me are there again hopes, tasks, prescribable paths of culture I am the bringer of the good tidings of these . Precisely therewith am I a destiny. - 3 Immediately upon completing the said work and without losing so much as a day, I attacked the tremendous task of the Revaluation in a sovereign feeling of pride beyond compare, sure of my immortality every moment and engraving sign upon sign in brass tablets with the sureness of a destiny. The foreword was written on 3 September 1888: when in the morning after this writing I stepped outside I found awaiting me the loveliest day the Ober-Engadin had ever shown me - transparent, glowing in its colours, containing in itself every antithesis, every mediant between ice and south. - Only on 20 September did I leave Sils-Maria, detained there by floods, finally by far the last guest of this wonderful place to which my gratitude would like to make the gift of an immortal name. After a journey with incidents, even being in peril of my life in the flooded Como, which I reached only deep in the night, I arrived on the afternoon of the twenty-first in Turin, my proved place, my Resident[^] from now on. I took again the same accom- modation I had occupied in the spring, via Carlo Alberto 6, HI, opposite the mighty palazzo Carignano, in which Vittorio Emanuele was born, with a view of the pia[^]a Carlo Alberto and beyond that to the hills. Without delay and without letting myself be distracted for a moment I resumed work: only the last quarter of the book remained to be done. On 30 September a great victory; seventh day; a god takes his leisure on the banks of the Po. On the same day I went on to write the foreword to the 'Twilight of the Idols', correction of the proofs of which had been my recreation during September. - I have 87 ECCE HOMO never experienced such an autumn, nor have I thought anything of the sort possible on earth - a Claude Lorrain thought

on to infinity, every day of the same excessive perfection. - THE WAGNER CASE A Musicians' Problem If one is to be fair to this writing one has to suffer from the destiny of music as from an open wound. - What is it I suffer from when I suffer from the destiny of music? From this: that music has been deprived of its world-transfiguring, affirmative character, that it is decadence music and no longer the flute of Dionysos... Supposing, however, that one in this way feels the cause of music to be one's own cause, to be the history of one's own suffering, one will find this writing full of consideration and mild beyond measure. In such cases to be cheerful and good-naturedly to mock at oneself as well - *ridendo dicere severum* where *verum dicere* would justify every kind of severity - is humaneness itself. Who really doubts that I, old artilleryist that I am, have the ability to bring up my heavy guns against Wagner? — I kept to myself everything decisive in this matter - I have loved Wagner. - Ultimately this is an attack on a subtle 'unknown*' who could not easily be detected by another, in the sense and direction of my task - oh, I have still got quite other 'unknowns' to reveal than a Cagliostro of music - even more, to be sure, an attack on the German nation growing ever more sluggish and poor in instinct in spiritual matters, ever more honourable, which with an enviable appetite continues to nourish itself with opposites and knows how to gulp down 'faith' as well as scientificity, 'Christian love' as well as anti-Semitism, will to power (to the 'Reich') as well as the *evangile des humbles*, without having any trouble digesting them. This lack of party in choosing between opposites! This ventral neutrality and 'selflessness'! This fairness of German taste, which accords 89 ECCE HOMO everything equal rights - which finds everything tasty... Without any doubt the Germans are idealists... When I last visited Germany I found German taste occupied in trying to accord Wagner and the Trumpeter of Sackingen equal rights; I myself witnessed how in Leipzig, to the honour of one of the most genuine and German musicians in the old sense of the word German, no mere Reich German, Meister Heinrich Schütz, they founded a Liszt Society for the encouragement and propagation of cunning church music... Without any doubt the Germans are idealists... But here nothing shall stop me from becoming rude and telling the Germans a couple of hard truths: who else will do it? - I speak of their indecency in historicis. German historians have not only altogether lost the grand view for the course, for the values of culture, and are one and all buffoons of politics (or of the church -): they have even outlawed this grand view. One has first of all to be 'German', to have 'race', then one can arbitrate over all values and disvalues in historicis - one determines them. 'German' is an argument, 'Deutschland, Deutschland über alles*' a principle, the Germans represent the 'moral world-order' in history; in relation to the *imperium romanum* the bearers of freedom, in relation to the eighteenth century the restorers of morality, of the 'categorical imperative'... There is a *reichs-deutsch*

historiography, there is, I am afraid, even an anti-Semitic one - there is a court historiography and Herr von Treitschke is not ashamed... Recently an idiotic judgement in historicis, a proposition of the happily late Swabian aesthete Vischer, went the rounds of the German newspapers as a 'truth' to which every German had to say Yes: 'The Renaissance and the Reformation, both together constitute a whole - the aesthetic rebirth and the moral rebirth'. - In face of such propositions my patience runs out, and I sense a desire, I feel it even to be a duty, to tell the Germans for once what they already have on 90 THE WAGNER CASE their conscience. I:rcry great cultural crime offour centuries is what they have on their conscience^... . And always from the lame cause, from their most inherent cowardice in face of reality, which is also cowardice in face of truth, from the falseness which has become instinct with them, from 'idealism'.. . The Germans deprived Europe of the seriousness, of the meaning of the last great age, the age of the Renaissance, at a moment when a higher order of values, when the noble, life-affirmative values which guarantee the future had achieved victory at the seat of the antithetical values, the values of decline - and even into the instincts of him who sat on it\ Luther, that fatality of a monk, restored the church and, what is a thousand times worse, Christianity, at the moment of its defeat... Christianity, that denial of the will to life become religion! . Luther, who found it impossible to be a monk and who because of this 'impossibility' attacked the church and - consequently! - restored it... Catholics would have reason to celebrate Luther Festivals, compose Luther plays... Luther - and 'moral rebirth'! To the devil with all psychology! - Without doubt the Germans are idealists. - Twice, at precisely the moment when with tremendous courage and self-overcoming an honest, an unambiguous, a completely scientific mode of thinking had been attained, the Germans have known how to discover secret paths to the old 'ideal', reconciliations between truth and 'ideal', at bottom formulas for a right to reject science, for a right to lie. Leibniz and Kant - those two greatest impediments to the intellectual integrity of Europe! - Finally, when on the bridge between two decadence centuries a force majeure of genius and will became visible, strong enough to forge Europe into a political and economic unity for the purpose of ruling the earth, the Germans with their 'Wars of Liberation' deprived Europe of the meaning, of the miracle of meaning of the existence of Napoleon — they thereby have on their conscience everything that followed, that exists today, this sickness and unreason the most inimical to culture there is, nationalism, that nevrose nationale with which Europe is sick, that eternalizing of the petty-state situation of 9 1 ECCE HOMO Europe, of petty politics: they have deprived Europe itself of its meaning, of its reason - they have led it into a blind alley. - Does anyone except me know a way out of this blind alley? A task great enough once again to unite the peoples? 3 - And why should I not in the end give expression to my suspicions? In my case too the Germans will again try every-

thing to bring forth a mouse out of a tremendous destiny. Up to now they have compromised themselves with me, I doubt if they will do better in the future. - Ah, how I would like to be a false prophet in this instance!.. . The readers and auditors most natural to me are still Russians, Scandinavians and French - will they always be so? - In the history of knowledge the Germans are represented by nothing but ambiguous names, they have ever produced only 'unconscious' false-coiners (- Fichte, Schelling, Schopenhauer, Hegel, Schleiermacher deserve this description as well as Kant and Leibniz; they are all mere Schleiermacher\ mere veilmakers -); they ought never to have the honour of harbouring the first honest spirit in the history of the spirit, the spirit in whom truth comes to judgement on the false-coinage of four millennia. The 'German spirit' is my bad air: I find it hard to breathe in the proximity of this uncleanness in psychologics become instinct which every word, every gesture of a German betrays. They never went through a seventeenth century of hard self-examination as the French did - a La Rochefoucauld, a Descartes is a hundred times superior in integrity to the leading Germans - to this day they have had no psychologists. But psychology is almost the measure of the cleanliness or uncleanness of a race . And if one is not even clean how should one possess depth? With the German, almost as with the woman, one never gets to the bottom, he has none\ that is all. But in that event one is not even shallow. - That which is in Germany called 'deep' is precisely this uncleanness of instinct towards oneself of which I speak: one does not want 9 1 I ill WAGNER CASE to DC clear about oneself. Might I not suggest the word 'German' as an international counter for this psychological depravity? At this moment, for example, the German Kaiser calls it his 'Christian duty' to free the slaves in Africa: among us other Europeans let that be called simply 'German' I have the Germans produced even one book that possessed profundity? They even lack any idea of what constitutes profundity in a book. I have known scholars who considered Kant profound; at the Prussian court, I fear, they consider Herr von Treitschke profound. And when I have occasionally praised Stendhal as a profound psychologist, it has happened to me that German university professors have asked me to spell his name - And why should I not go on to the end? I like to make a clean sweep. It is even part of my ambition to count as the despiser of the German par excellence. I expressed my mistrust of the German character already at the age of twenty-six (third untimely essay) - the Germans are impossible for me. Whenever I picture to myself a type of man that goes against all my instincts it always turns into a German. The first thing in which I 'test the reins' of a person is whether he has in him a feeling for distance, whether he sees everywhere rank, degree, order between man and man, whether he distinguishes-, one is thereby a gentleman; in any other event one belongs irretrievably to the wide-hearted, alas! so good-hearted concept of the canaille. But the Germans are canaille - alas! they are so good-natured... One lowers

oneself by commerce with Germans: the German posits as equal ... If I subtract my commerce with a few artists, above all with Richard Wagner, I have experienced not a single good hour with Germans.. . Supposing the profoundest spirit of all the millennia appeared among the Germans, some goose of the Capitol would opine that its very unbeautiful soul came at least equally into consideration ... I cannot endure this race, with which one is always in bad company, which has no ringer 93 ECCE HOMO for nuances - woe is me! I am a nuance - which has no esprit in its feet and cannot even walk ... In the end the Germans have no idea whatever how common they are; but that is the superlative of commonness - they are not even ashamed of being mere Germans.. . They feel free to discuss everything, they even consider themselves decisive, I fear they have even decided about me.. . My whole life is the proof de rigueur of these propositions. I seek in it in vain for a single sign of tact, of delicatessen towards me. From Jews yes, never yet from Germans. My nature directs that I am mild and benevolent towards everyone - I have a right not to make distinctions -: this does not prevent me from keeping my eyes open. I except no one, least of all my friends - I hope in the end that this has not diminished my humanity towards them! There are five or six things which have always been a point of honour with me. - It remains none the less true that almost every letter which has reached me for years past strikes me as a piece of cynicism: there is more cynicism in benevolence towards me than in any kind of hatred ... I tell each of my friends to his face that he never thinks it worth the trouble to study any of my writings: I divine from the smallest of signs that they do not even know what is in them. As for my Zarathustra, who of my friends would have seen more in it than an impermissible piece of presumption but one that was fortunately a matter of complete indifference?... . Ten years: and no one in Germany has made it a question of conscience to defend my name against the absurd silence under which it has lain buried: it was a foreigner, a Dane, who was the first to possess sufficient refinement of instinct and courage for that, who inveighed against my supposed friends ... At which German university today would lectures on my philosophy be possible such as were given last spring by Dr Georg Brandes in Copenhagen - who therewith once more proved himself a psychologist? - I myself have never suffered from any of this; I am not injured by what is necessary; amor fati is my innermost nature. This does not mean, however, that I do not enjoy the irony, even the world-historic irony. And so, 94 THE WACNFK CASE about two years before the shattering thunder-clap of the Revaluation which will set the earth into convulsions, I sent the 'Wagner Case' into the world: my notion was that the Germans should once more blunder immortally about me and so eternalize themselves! there was just about enough time left! - Was that achieved? - Charming! my Herr- Teutons! I compliment you... WHY I AM A DESTINY I know my fate. One day there will be associated with my name the

recollection of something frightful - of a crisis like no other before on earth, of the profoundest collision of con- science, of a decision evoked against everything that until then had been believed in, demanded, sanctified. I am not a man, I am dynamite. - And with all that there is nothing in me of a founder of a religion - religions are affairs of the rabble, I have need of washing my hands after contact with religious people I do not want 'believers', I think I am too malicious to believe in myself, I never speak to masses ... I have a terrible fear I shall one day be pronounced holy, one will guess why I bring out this book beforehand; it is intended to prevent people from making mischief with me ... I do not want to be a saint, rather even a buffoon... Perhaps I am a buffoon.. . And none the less, or rather not none the less - for there has hitherto been nothing more mendacious than saints - the truth speaks out of me. - But my truth is dreadful: for hitherto the lie has been called truth. - Revaluation of all values: this is my formula for an act of supreme coming-to-oneself on the part of mankind which in me has become flesh and genius. It is my fate to have to be the first decent human being, to know myself in opposition to the mendaciousness of millennia ... I was the first to discover the truth, in that I was the first to sense - smell - the lie as lie.. . My genius is in my nostrils... I contradict as has never been contradicted and am none the less the opposite of a negative spirit. I am a bringer of good tidings such as there has never been, I know tasks from such a height that any conception of them 96 WHY I AM A DESTINY has hitherto been lacking; only after me is it possible to hope- again. With all that I am necessarily a man of fatality, for when truth steps into battle with the lie of millennia we shall have convulsions, an earthquake spasm, a transposition of valley and mountain such as has never been dreamed of. The concept politics has then become completely absorbed into a war of spirits, all the power-structures of the old society have been blown into the air - they one and all reposed on the lie: there will be wars such as there have never yet been on earth. Only after me will there be. grand politics on earth. Does one want a formula for a destiny that has become man? It stands in my Zarathustra. — and he who wants to be a creator in good and evil has first to be a destroyer and break values. Thus the greatest evil belongs with the greatest good: this, however, is the creative good. I am by far the most terrible human being there has ever been; this does not mean I shall not be the most beneficent. I know joy in destruction to a degree corresponding to my strength for destruction - in both I obey my dionysian nature, which does not know how to separate No-doing from Yes-saying. I am the first immoralist: I am therewith the destroyer par excellence. - 3 I have not been asked, as I should have been asked, what the name Zarathustra means in precisely my mouth, in the mouth of the first immoralist: for what constitutes the tremendous uniqueness of that Persian in history is precisely the opposite of this. Zarathustra was the first to see in the struggle between good and evil the actual wheel in the working of things: the 97

ECCE HOMO translation of morality into the realm of metaphysics, as force, cause, end-in-itself, is his work. But this question is itself at bottom its own answer. Zarathustra created this most fateful of errors, morality: consequently he must also be the first to recognise it. Not only has he had longer and greater experience here than any other thinker - the whole of history is indeed the experimental refutation of the proposition of a so-called 'moral world-order' -: what is more important is that Zarathustra is more truthful than any other thinker. His teaching, and his alone, upholds truthfulness as the supreme virtue - that is to say, the opposite of the cowardice of the 'idealist', who takes flight in face of reality; Zarathustra has more courage in him than all other thinkers put together. To tell the truth and to shoot well with arrows: that is Persian virtue. - Have I been understood? The self-overcoming of morality through truthfulness, the self-overcoming of the moralist into his opposite - into me - that is what the name Zarathustra means in my mouth. At bottom my expression immoralist involves two denials. I deny first a type of man who has hitherto counted as the highest, the good, the benevolent, beneficent; I deny secondly a kind of morality which has come to be accepted and to dominate as morality in itself - decadence morality, in more palpable terms Christian morality. The second contradiction might be seen as the decisive one, since the over-valuation of goodness and benevolence by and large already counts with me as a consequence of decadence, as a symptom of weakness, as incompatible with an ascending and affirmative life: denial and destruction is a condition of affirmation. - I deal first of all with the psychology of the good man. In order to assess what a type of man is worth one has to compute how much his preservation costs - one has to know the conditions of his existence. The condition for the existence of the good is the lie -: expressed differently, the desire not to see at any price what is the fundamental constitution of reality, that is to say not such as to call forth benevolent instincts at all times, even less such as to permit at all times an interference by short-sighted good-natured hands. To regard states of distress in general as an objection, as something that must be abolished, is the *niaiserie* par excellence, in a general sense a real disaster in its consequences, a fatality of stupidity - almost as stupid as would be the will to abolish bad weather - perhaps from pity to the poor... In the general economy of the whole the fearfulnesses of reality (in the affects, in the desires, in the will to power) are to an incalculable degree more necessary than any form of petty happiness, so-called 'goodness'; since the latter is conditioned by falsity of instinct one must even be cautious about granting it a place at all. I shall have a grand occasion of demonstrating the measurelessly uncanny consequences for the whole of history of optimism, that offspring of the *homines optimi*. Zarathustra, the first to grasp that optimism is just as decadent as pessimism and perhaps more harmful, says: good men never tell the truth. The good taught you false shores

and false securities: you were born and kept in the lies of the good. Everything has been distorted and twisted down to its very bottom through the good. Fortunately the world has not been constructed for the satisfaction of instincts such as would permit merely good-natured herd animals to find their narrow happiness in it; to demand that everything should become 'good man', herd animal, blue-eyed, benevolent, 'beautiful soul' - or, as Mr Herbert Spencer wants, altruistic, would mean to deprive existence of its great character, would mean to castrate mankind and to reduce it to a paltry Chinadom. -And this has been attempted!... Precisely this has been called morality ... In this sense Zarathustra calls the good now 'the last men', now the 'beginning of the end'; above all he feels them to be the most harmful species of man, because they preserve their existence as much at the expense of truth as at the expense of the future. The good - cannot create, they are always the beginning of the end- 99 ECCE HOMO - they crucify him who writes new values on new law-tables, they sacrifice the future to themselves, they crucify the whole human future! The good - have always been the beginning of the end And whatever harm the world-calumniators may do, the harm the good do is the most harmful harm. 5 Zarathustra, the first psychologist of the good, is - consequently - a friend of the wicked. When a decadence-species of man has risen to the rank of the highest species of man, this can happen only at the expense of its antithetical species, the species of man strong and certain of life. When the herd-animal is resplendent in the glow of the highest virtue, the exceptional man must be devalued to the wicked man. When mendaciousness at any price appropriates the word 'truth' for its perspective, what is actually veracious must be discovered bearing the worst names. Zarathustra here leaves no doubt: he says that it was knowledge of precisely the good, the 'best', which made him feel horror at man in general; it was out of this repugnance that the wings grew which 'carried him to distant futures' - he does not dissemble that it is precisely in relation to the good that his type of man, a relatively superhuman type, is superhuman, that the good and just would call his superman a devil You highest men my eyes have encountered! This is my doubt of you and my secret laughter: I think you would call my superman - a devil! Your souls are so unfamiliar with what is great that the superman would be fearful to you in his goodness It is at this point and nowhere else that one must make a start if one is to understand what Zarathustra's intentions are: the species of man he delineates delineates reality as it is: he is strong enough for it - he is not estranged from or entranced by it WHY I AM A IM s I I \V it, he is reality itself, he still has all that is fearful and questionable in reality in him, only thus can man possess greatness - But there is also another sense in which I have chosen for myself the word immoralist as a mark of distinction and badge of honour; I am proud to possess this word which sets me off against the whole of humanity. No one has yet felt Christian morality as beneath him: that requires a

height, a farsightedness, a hitherto altogether unheard-of psychological profundity and abysmalness. Christian morality has hitherto been the Circe of all thinkers - they stood in its service. - Who before me has entered the caverns out of which the poisonous blight of this kind of ideal - world-calumny I - wells up? Who has even ventured to suspect that these caverns exist? Who before me at all among philosophers has been a psychologist and not rather its opposite 'higher swindler', 'idealist'? Before me there was no psychology. - To be the first here can be a curse, it is in any case a destiny: for one is also the first to despise... Disgust at mankind is my danger.. Have I been understood? - What defines me, what sets me apart from all the rest of mankind, is that I have unmasked Christian morality. That is why I needed a word which would embody the sense of a challenge to everyone. Not to have opened its eyes here sooner counts to me as the greatest piece of uncleanness which humanity has on its conscience, as self- deception become instinct, as a fundamental will not to observe every event, every cause, every reality, as false-coinage in psycho- logicis to the point of crime. Blindness in the face of Christianity is the crime par excellence - the crime against life . The millennia, the peoples, the first and the last, the philosophers and the old women - except for five or six moments of history, me as the IOI ECCE HOMO seventh - on this point they are all worthy of one another. The Christian has hitherto been the 'moral being', a curiosity without equal - and, as 'moral being', more absurd, mendacious, vain, frivolous, harmful to himself than even the greatest despiser of mankind could have allowed himself to dream. Christian moral- ity - the most malicious form of the will to the lie, the actual Circe of mankind: that which has ruined it. It is not error as error which horrifies me at the sight of this, not the millennia- long lack of 'good will', of discipline, of decency, of courage in spiritual affairs which betrays itself in its victory - it is the lack of nature, it is the utterly ghastly fact that anti-nature itself has received the highest honours as morality, and has hung over mankind as law, as categorical imperative! ... To blunder to this extent, not as an individual, not as a people, but as mankind! . That contempt has been taught for the primary instincts of life; that a 'soul', a 'spirit' has been lyingly invented in order to destroy the body; that one teaches that there is something unclean in the precondition of life, sexuality; that the evil principle is sought in that which is most profoundly necessary for prosperity, in strict selfishness (- the very word is slander- ous!); that on the other hand one sees in the typical signs of decline and contradictoriness of instinct, in the 'selfless', in loss of centre of gravity, in 'depersonalization' and 'love of one's neighbour' (- lust for one's neighbour!) the higher value, what am I saying! value in itself... . What\ could mankind itself be in decadence? has it always been? - What is certain is that it has been taught only decadence values as supreme values. The morality of unselfing is the morality of decline par excellence, the fact 'I am perishing' translated into the imperative 'you all shall perish' - and not

only into the imperative! . This sole morality which has hitherto been taught, the morality of unselfing, betrays a will to the end, it denies the very foundations of life. - Let us here leave the possibility open that it is not mankind which is degenerating but only that parasitic species of man the priest, who with the aid of morality has lied himself up to being the determiner of mankind's values - who divines in Christian 102 WHY I AM A DESTINY morality his means to power.. . And that is in fact my insight: the teachers, the leaders of mankind, theologians included, have also one and all been decadents: thence the revaluation of all values into the inimical to life, thence morality... Definition of morality, morality - the idiosyncrasy of decadents with the hidden intention of avenging themselves on life - and successfully. I set store by this definition. - 8 - Have I been understood? - I have not just now said a word that I could not have said five years ago through the mouth of Zarathustra. - The unmasking of Christian morality is an event without equal, a real catastrophe. He who exposes it is a force majeure, a destiny - he breaks the history of mankind into two parts. One lives before him, one lives after him... The lightning-bolt of truth struck precisely that which formerly stood highest: he who grasps what was then destroyed had better see whether he has anything at all left in his hands. Everything hitherto called 'truth' is recognized as the most harmful, malicious, most subterranean form of the lie; the holy pretext of 'improving' mankind as the cunning to suck out life itself and to make it anaemic. Morality as vampirism . He who unmasks morality has therewith unmasked the valuelessness of all values which are or have been believed in; he no longer sees in the most revered, even canonized types of man anything venerable, he sees in them the most fateful kind of abortion, fateful because they exercise fascination.. . The concept 'God' invented as the antithetical concept to life - everything harmful, noxious, slanderous, the whole mortal enmity against life brought into one terrible unity! The concept 'the Beyond', 'real world' invented so as to deprive of value the only world which exists - so as to leave over no goal, no reason, no task for our earthly reality! The concept 'soul', 'spirit', finally even 'immortal soul', invented so as to despise the body, so as to make it sick - 'holy' - so as to bring to all the things in life which deserve 103 ECCE HOMO serious attention, the questions of nutriment, residence, cleanliness, weather, a horrifying frivolity! Instead of health 'salvation of the soul' - which is to say a/o//> circulaire between spasms of atonement and redemption hysteria! The concept 'sin' invented together with the instrument of torture which goes with it, the concept of 'free will', so as to confuse the instincts, so as to make mistrust of the instincts into second nature! In the concept of the 'selfless', of the 'self-denying' the actual badge of decadence, being lured by the harmful, no longer being able to discover where one's advantage lies, self-destruction, made the sign of value in general, made 'duty', 'holiness', the 'divine' in man! Finally - it is the most fearful - in the

concept of the good man common cause made with everything weak, sick, ill-constructed, suffering from itself, all that which ought to perish - the law of selection crossed, an ideal made of opposition to the proud and well-constituted, to the affirmative man, to the man certain of the future and guaranteeing the future - the latter is henceforth called the evil man.. . And all this was believed in as morality. - *Ecrasez l'enfer!* — 9 Have I been understood? - Dionysos against the Crucified NOTES FOREWORD i. heaviest demand. The forthcoming Revaluation of all Values - together with the effect it may be expected to produce - is presumably what is meant. 3. *Nitimur in vetitum*. We strive after the forbidden (Ovid). 4. 'It is the stillest... guide the world' Quoted from Thus Spoke Zarathustra, Part Two: 'The Stillest Hour'. The figs are falling.. . sky and afternoon. Quoted from Zarathustra, Part Two: 'On the Blissful Islands'. decadent. Nietzsche employs, here and elsewhere, the French word, since none with precisely this meaning was available to him in German. I now go away... will I return to you. Quoted from Zarathustra, Part One: 'Of the Bestowing Virtue'. 'On This Perfect Day.. .' first book of the Revaluation of all Values. Nietzsche was at the date of *Ecce Homo* still referring to the just completed *Anti-Christ* as the first book of the forthcoming Revaluation. Either immediately before or immediately after the mental breakdown of 3 January 1889 he withdrew this designation by erasing it from the title-page of the manuscript. Songs of Zarathustra: i.e. the Dionysos-Dithyramben, published in 1892. Why I am So Wise 2. as *summa summarum*: as a totality. This seems to have been a 'family legend' which Nietzsche's hatred of the Reich inspired him to 105 NOTES propagate during his last sane years; but it is refuted by the genealogical evidence. Nietzsche's ancestry has been traced back to the sixteenth century and over two hundred ancestors are known: all are German, and the name Nietzsche is, together with its cognate forms (e.g. Nitsche, Nitzke), a common one in central Germany. At the end of December 1888 Nietzsche posted to his publisher a set of corrections to the manuscript of *Ecce Homo*. The revised section 3 was discovered among the papers of Peter Gast in the Nietzsche collection of the Goethe-Schiller Archive in Weimar in 1969. Gast had sent the manuscript of this section to Nietzsche's mother and sister, who destroyed it; but he had copied it out. This is the first edition of *Ecce Homo* in English to include it. The passage reproduced below is the original section 3 published in the first edition, and all subsequent English translations. This twofold succession of experiences, this accessibility to me of apparently separate worlds, is repeated in my nature in every respect - I am a Doppelgänger, I have a 'second' face in addition to the first one. And perhaps also a third. Even by virtue of my descent I am permitted to look beyond all merely locally, merely nationally conditioned perspectives, it costs me no effort to be a 'good European'. On the other hand I am perhaps more German than present-day Germans, mere Reich Germans, are still capable of

being - I the last anti-political German. And yet my ancestors were Polish noblemen: I have preserved from them much racial instinct, who knows? ultimately even the liberum veto. When I consider how often I am addressed as a Pole and by Poles themselves, how rarely I am taken for a German, it might appear that German has only been sprinkled on to me. But my mother, Franziska Oehler, is in any event something very German; likewise my paternal grandmother, Erdmutha Krause. The latter lived her entire youth in the middle of good old Weimar, not without coming into contact with Goethe's circle. Her brother, Professor of Theology Krause of Königsberg, was called to Weimar as general superintendent after Herder's death. It is not impossible that her mother, my great-grandmother, appears in the young Goethe's diary under the name 'Muthgen'. Her second marriage was with the superintendent Nietzsche of Eilenburg; it was on the day of the great war year 1813 on which Napoleon entered Eilenburg with his general staff, on 10 October, 106 NOTES that she had her confinement. As a Saxon she was a great admirer of Napoleon; it could be that I am so still. My father born 1813, died 1849. Before he took over the pastorship of the parish of Rockcn, not far from Liitzen, he lived for some years in the castle of Altenburg and instructed the four princesses there. His pupils are the Queen of Hanover, Grand-Duchess Constantin, the Grand-Duchess of Oldenburg and Princess Therese of Saxe-Altenburg. He was full of a deep reverence for King Friedrich Wilhelm the Fourth of Prussia, from whom he also received his pastorship; the events of 1848 distressed him beyond measure. I myself, born on the birthday of the said king, on 15 October, received as was appropriate the Hohenzollern names Friedrich Wilhelm. The choice of this day had at any rate one advantage: throughout my entire childhood my birthday was a holiday. - I regard it as a great privilege to have had such a father: it even seems to me that whatever else of privileges I possess is thereby explained - life, the great Yes to life, not included. Above all that it requires no intention on my part, but only a mere waiting, for me to enter involuntarily into a world of exalted and delicate things: I am at home there, my innermost passion becomes free only there. That I paid for this privilege almost with my life is certainly no unfair trade. - To understand anything at all of my Zarathustra one has perhaps to possess a qualification similar to that which I possess - to have one foot beyond life 'good European' \ a coinage of Nietzsche's, probably as an antithesis to 'good German'. liberum veto: the right to veto legislation possessed by the nobility of the Polish Diet. the events of 1848: the revolutionary outbreaks in many parts of Europe which characterized this year. 4. Heinrich von Stein. He had been tutor to Wagner's son, Siegfried, and Wagner's last published writing was an introduction to his book *Heiden und Welt* (1883). He died in 1887, at the age of thirty. swamp of Diihring. Eugen Diihring (1833-1901), philosopher and economist. The 'swamp' is probably anti-Semitism. 'Zarathustra's Temptation*': Part Four of Thus

Spoke Zarathustra is meant. 6. resentment. French in the original, for a similar reason to the author's employment of decadent. 107 NOTES 8. pure folly. A favourite joke of Nietzsche's, here not very apposite. (1 quote the note on it from my translation of *Twilight of the Idols*: Parsifal, eponymous hero of Wagner's last opera, is described as a pure, i.e. chaste, fool [reine Tor] whose naivety is proof against temptation of every kind. Nietzsche considered the plot of Parsifal preposterous and persistently uses the phrase 'reine Torheit' [pure folly] in the sense of complete folly.) Yet what happened... against the wind. Quoted, with slight alteration, from Zarathustra, Part Two: 'Of the Rabble'. Why I am So Clever i. (/ is said... in this domain): due, presumably, to the occupation of Saxony by Prussia during the German War of 1866. alia tedesca: in the German fashion. Piedmont: the Italian province of which Turin, where *Ecce Homo* was written, is the chief city. Assiduity... holy spirit. Quoted from *Twilight of the Idols*. Liszt, Wagner's second wife and (by the date of *Ecce Homo*) widow. ex ungue Napoleonem: from the claw, Napoleon (from ex ungue leonum = from the claw [you can reconstruct or infer] the lion). 4. mere Germans: Heine was a Jew, Nietzsche supposed himself descended from Poles (see note above). American shallow-pates and muddle-heads. Alludes to the American origin of the Baconian movement, with the implication that Nietzsche does not derive his own views from it. 9. nosce te ipsum: know thyself. 10. amor fati: love of (one's) fate. Why I Write Such Good Books 1. 'non legor, non legar': I am not read, I will not be read. Dr V. Widmann (1842-1911), minor Swiss poet. Karl Spitteler (1845-1924), major Swiss writer, Nobel Prize-winner for literature in 1919. 1. Kreuzzeitung: an extreme reactionary newspaper. 3. 'beautiful souls': phrase from Goethe's *Wilhelm Meisters Lehrjahre*. Toyon... hate to calculate. Quoted from Zarathustra, Part Three: 'Of the Vision and the Riddle'. 108 NOTES 5. eternal-womanly: from the concluding chorus of Goethe's

Part XI

Dithyrambs of Dionysus

1888 — Translated by R.J. Hollingdale

[Page 2] FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE Dithyrambs of Dionysus (DIONYSOS-DITHYRAMBEN) translated with an introduction and notes by R. J. HOLLINGDALE Anvil Press Poetry [Page 3] Published in 1984 by Anvil Press Poetry Ltd 69 King George Street London SE10 8PX ISBN 0 85646 119 2 (hardback) ISBN 0 85646 120 2 (paperback) Copyright© R. J. Hollingdale 1984 This book is published with financial assistance from The Arts Council of Great Britain Set in V-1-P Imprint by Fakenham Photosetting Ltd Fakenham, Norfolk Printed and bound in England by The Camelot Press Ltd, Southampton [Page 4] Contents INTRODUCTION Only a Fool! Only a Poet! Nur Narr! Nur Dichter! The Desert Grows: Woe to Him Who Harbours Deserts ... Die Wüste wächst: weh dem, der Wüsten birgt ... Last Will Letzter Wille Amid Birds of Prey Zwischen Raubvögeln The Fire-Signal Das Feuerzeichen The Sun Sinks Die Sonne sinkt Ariadne's Complaint Klage der Ariadne Fame and Eternity Ruhm und Ewigkeit Of the Poverty of the Richest Man Von der Armut des Reichsten NOTES 23 47 53 77 [Page 6] Introduction I FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE was born in 1844 and produced the philosophical writings on which his claim to attention mainly rests during the 1870s and 1880s; in 1889 he suffered a mental breakdown which terminated his productivity, and he died in 1900. His reputation, which now stands higher than it has ever done before, is that of a thinker whose insights and influence mark a new stage in the progress of Western thought, and it is now normal to rank him with Marx and Freud as one of the creators of the twentieth century; his earliest reputation, however, which he acquired during the 1890s, was that of a German philosopher who, very surprisingly, wrote poetry. He began writing poetry, in fact, when he was still a boy, well before he had any interest in matters that could be called, even in a juvenile sense, philosophical. His attempts at verse were paralleled by attempts at musical composition, and until about 1860 his whole development seemed to be that of a potential "artist" of some sort. Composition was, in the end, never more than a hobby (at bottom no more than an extension of improvising at the piano); but to the writing of poetry he gave from the first the kind of attention that could be called professional: he appears to have realized that, while the content of what he wrote at the age of fifteen could be only derivative and juvenile, this would later on take care of itself if only he was able to master the technique of writing

in verse. He applied himself to this with genuine dedication and produced a body of "juvenilia" whose subject-matter is conventional and uninteresting but which shows a steady advance in technical ability that is clearly the consequence of deliberate application and practice. He then continued to write poetry, in a large range of styles, for the remainder of his active life. [Page 7] Most of the verse he wished to preserve he published within the framework of his philosophical works, the only exceptions being the collection *Idyllen aus Messina* (1882), which appeared in a magazine, and the *Dionysos Dithyramben*. The earliest large selection of his poems, published and hitherto unpublished, appeared in 1898 under the title *Gedichte und Sprüche*. Nietzsche's mature poetry is of four distinct kinds. Firstly, there are the brief, rhymed epigrammatic pieces: they make a single point in the fewest possible words, and are in essence a manifestation of the pleasure he always took in expressing himself aphoristically. "My ambition", he wrote in *Twilight of the Idols*, "is to say in ten sentences what everyone else says in a book- what everyone else does not say in a book"; and an "un-German" conciseness and presto is a general characteristic of his style even when he is not writing aphoristically. Here are some examples.

FUR TANZER Glattes Eis Ein Paradeis Für den, der gut zu tanzen weiß. (For Dancers Smooth ice [is] a paradise for him who knows how to dance well.)

MEINE HARTE Ich muß weg über hundert Stufen, Ich muß empor und hör euch rufen: "Hart bist du! Sind wir denn von Stein?" - Ich muß weg über hundert Stufen, Und niemand möchte Stufe sein. (My Kind of Hardness I have to pass over a hundred steps, I have to go up and I hear you cry: "How hard you are! Do you think we're made of stone?" I have to pass over a hundred steps, and no one wants to be a step.) [Page 8]

DERNACHSTE Nah hab den Nächsten ich nicht gerne: Fort mit ihm in die Höhe und Ferne! Wie wird er sonst zu meinem Sterne? - (My Neighbour I don't like my neighbour near me. Away with him into distant heights! How otherwise could he become my star?) Wer viel einst zu verkünden hat, schweigt viel in sich hinein. Wer einst den Blitz zu zünden hat, muß lange - Wolke sein. (He who has much to proclaim one day, stays silently much immersed within himself. He who has to kindle the lightning one day, must for a long time - be a cloud.)

Then there are the poems of more conventional length and subject whose most obvious model is the briefer poems of Heinrich Heine, of whom Nietzsche was an unqualified admirer ("The highest conception of the lyric poet was given me by Heinrich Heine ... He possessed that divine malice without which I cannot imagine perfection ... It will one day be said that Heine and I have been by far the first artists of the German language." - *Ecce Homo*):

Dorthin - will ich ; und ich traue Mir fortan und meinem Griff. Offen liegt das Meer, ins Blaue Treibt mein Genueser Schiff. Alles glänzt mir neu und neuer, Mittag schläft auf Raum und Zeit -: Nur dein Auge - ungeheuer Blickt michs an, Unendlichkeit! (I will away - and henceforth I trust in myself and in my own

hands. Open lies the sea, my Genoese ship surges onward into the blue. Everything glitters new and newer, noontide sleeps on space and time: your eye alone - dreadfully it gazes upon me, infinity!) [Page 9] Thirdly, and among the best known, are the experiments in rhythmic effects: *Mistral-Wind, du Wolken-Jäger, Triibsal-Morder, Himmels-Feger, Brausender, wie lieb ich dich! Sind wir zwei nicht eines Schoes Erstlingsgabe, eines Loses Vorbestimmte ewiglich?* (*Mistral wind, you hunter of clouds, killer of affliction, scourer of the skies, blusterer, how I love you! Are we two not the first fruit of one womb, eternally predestined for one fate? ["An den Mistral", opening stanza]*) *Ja I Ich wei, woher ich stamme I Ungesattigt gleich der Flamme Gliihe und verzehr ich mich. Licht wird alles, was ich fasse, Kahle alles, was ich lasse: Flamme bin ich sicherlich.* (*Yes, I know whence I have sprung I Insatiable as a flame I burn and consume myself! Whatever I seize hold on becomes light, whatever I leave, ashes: certainly I am a flame. - [Ecce Homo]*) Lastly, in point both of time and poetic intensity, we have the free, "dithyrambic" verse of which the collection *Dithyrambs of Dionysus* is the final form. The *Dithyrambs of Dionysus*, in the precise shape in which we have it, is among Nietzsche's last productions and for that reason is usually accounted one of the "*Werke des Zusammenbruchs*" -the works of the final quarter of x 888 during which his mental breakdown of the beginning of x was palpably preparing itself (the other "*Werke des Zusammenbruchs*" are *The Anti-Christ*, *Ecce Homo* and *Nietzsche contra Wagner*). The nine poems which constitute the collection were composed over the six-year period IO [Page 10] I-88; in the summer of I Nietzsche collected them together into their present form and made fair copies of them with the clear intention of having them printed, but in the event held them back from publication until the very end of the year. On I January I 889 he added the dedication which prefaces the collection: they are probably the last words he wrote before he suffered, two days later, the breakdown which rendered him incapable of further rational thought. The accepted date of his mental collapse is 3 January I 889; but Nietzsche had been in a condition of pathological euphoria for the preceding three months at least and there is no question but that by the turn of the year he was already experiencing difficulty in ordering his thoughts rationally. The brief foreword to *Nietzsche contra Wagner*, for instance, which is dated "Christmas I 888", ends with three sentences which, though rational in themselves, have no obvious connection with what has gone before or with the subject of the book. It is a similar apparent disconnectedness - "apparent" because, of course, a connection does exist, though it is not a rational one - that characterizes the relationship between this dedication and the collection of poems which follows it. Except for his first book, *The Birth of Tragedy*, which is dedicated to Wagner, and the first edition of *Human, All Too Human*, which is dedicated "to the memory of Vol taire", none of Nietzsche's books bears a

dedication, so that the presence of a dedication here is in itself abnormal. What is harder still to understand, however, is the identity of the dedicatee: the "poet of Isoline", Catulle Mendes, is one of the last of Nietzsche's contemporaries with whom you would think he felt any affinity; remembered today, if he is remembered at all, mainly as a leading Parisian ally and advocate of Wagner, and possibly as the author of *Le Roi Vierge*, a novel satirizing the world of Ludwig II of Bavaria and those, including Wagner, who belonged to it, Mendes seems quite out of place in the company of the. Dithyrambs of Dionysus and Nietzsche's professed admiration for him inexplicable. (Except for the fact that both II [Page 11] Mendes and Nietzsche had been personally acquainted with Wagner, I can discover no biographical connection between the two.) Here we are already close to the region of the irrational into which Nietzsche entered wholly on 3 January, and it is a perception of this fact that has led editors of the *Dionysos-Dithyramben* to omit the dedication to Catulle Mendes: it is first included in the edition of Karl Schlechta (*Werke in drei Bänden*, vol. 2, 1955), which I follow. Having printed it, however, it is probably all the more necessary for me to emphasize that the nine poems are not products of the last quarter of 1888 but of an indeterminate though certainly much longer period, and that anyone who sought in them signs of "insanity" would be looking in the wrong place. Movement towards "free verse" was inherent in Nietzsche's prose style - or, better, in one of several prose styles which succeeded or accompanied one another during the course of his development - from the time of *Human, All Too Human* (published 1878) onwards, when the derivative, rather heavyweight "nineteenth-century German" in which he had hitherto written gave way principally to a manner both older (recalling the lighter hand of the eighteenth century) and more modern (especially in its simplification of syntax and livelier tempo). Here is an example of it: It is probable that the objects of the religious, moral and aesthetic sensations belong only to the surface of things, while man likes to believe that here at least he is in touch with the world's heart; the reason he deludes himself is that these things produce in him such profound happiness and unhappiness, and thus he exhibits here the same pride as in the case of astrology. For astrology believes that the starry firmament revolves around the fate of man; the moral man, however, supposes that what he has essentially at heart must also constitute the essence and heart of things. [*Human, All Too Human* 4] [Page 12] But at the same time as he was writing in this clean, "objective" manner, he also found satisfaction in a style of extended metaphor which brings to mind all too vividly that of the "model essay" whose defining characteristic is that it expresses a single, simple idea in as florid, far fetched, wordy and "poetic" a manner as the writer can achieve. Here is an example: In the desert of science. - To the man of science on his unassuming and laborious travels, which must often enough be journeys through the desert, there appear

those glittering mirages called "philosophical systems": with bewitching deceptive power they show the solution of all enigmas and the freshest draught of the true water of life to be near at hand; his heart rejoices, and it seems to the weary traveller that his lips already touch the goal of all the perseverance and sorrows of the scientific life, so that he involuntarily presses forward. There are other natures, to be sure, which stand still, as if bewildered by the fair illusion: the desert swallows them up and they are dead to science. Other natures again, which have often before experienced this subjective solace, may well grow exceedingly ill-humoured and curse the salty taste which these apparitions leave behind in the mouth and from which arises a raging thirst - without one having been brought so much as a single step nearer to any kind of spring. [Assorted Opinions and Maxims 31] In his case, however, the style of this passage and others like it is no more than a first, relatively primitive stage in the development of the style of compressed metaphor in which much of Thus Spoke Zarathustra (1883-85) is written: Life is a fountain of delight; but where the rabble also drinks all wells are poisoned . . . Many a one who went into the desert and suffered thirst with beasts of prey merely did not wish to sit around the cistern with dirty camel-drivers . . . Here, in the extremest height, the fountain of delight gushes up for me! And here there is a life at which no rabble drinks with me! . . . Gone is the lingering affliction of my spring! Gone the malice of my snowflakes in June! Summer have I become entirely, and summer-noonday! [Page 13] Rewritten in the style of "In the desert of science", this passage from Zarathustra would be extended to several pages; and the latter is in turn only a stage towards a style even more compressed in which almost every statement is metaphorical, and thus has in a sense to be interpreted before it can be understood, yet acts with the directness of impact normally attainable only by plain prose (i.e. prose whose implications are all on the surface): Let us look one another in the face. We are Hyperboreans - we know well enough how much out of the way we live. "Neither by land nor by sea shalt thou find the road to the Hyperboreans": Pindar already knew that of us. Beyond the North, beyond the ice, beyond death - our life, our happiness . . . We have discovered happiness, we know the road, we have found the exit out of whole millennia of labyrinth. Who else has found it? - Modern man perhaps? - "I know not which way to turn; I am everything that knows not which way to turn" - sighs modern man . . . It was from this modernity that we were ill - from lazy . peace, from cowardly compromise, from the whole virtuous uncleanness of modern Yes and No. This tolerance and largeness of heart which "forgives" everything because it "understands" everything is sirocco to us. Better to live among ice than among modern virtues and other south winds! . . . We were brave enough, we spared neither ourselves nor others: but for long we did not know where to apply our courage. We became gloomy, we were called fatalists. Our fatality - was the

plenitude, the tension, the blocking-up of our forces. We thirsted for lightning and action, of all things we kept ourselves furthest from the happiness of the weaklings, from "resignation" There was a thunderstorm in our air, the nature which we are grew dark- for we had no road. Formula 'of our happiness: a Yes, a No, a straight line, a goal [The Anti-Christ 1] In a passage such as this the distinction between "prose" and "poetry" has been narrowed to a merely technical one; and if a kind of poetry is envisaged - a kind usually called "free verse" - of which the only regulator is cadence, then there are many passages in Nietzsche's writings (principally though not only in Zarathustra) where all distinction between prose and poetry has disappeared: [Page 14] Allein bin ich wieder und will es sein, allein mit reinem Himmel und freiem Meere; und wieder. ist Nachmittag um mich. Allein bin ich wieder und will es sein, allein mit reinem Himmel und freiem Meere; und wieder ist Nachmittag um mich. (I am again alone and willingly so, alone with the pure sky and the open sea; and again it is afternoon around me. [Zarathustra III, von der Seligkeit wieder Willen]) Strongly cadenced prose and the style of compressed metaphor combined together define the "free verse" style of the Dithyrambs of Dionysus. Nietzsche's posthumously published notebooks contain many book-titles for which there are no corresponding books; and several of his published books received their final titles only after several provisional titles had been rejected. It is therefore not in itself surprising to find that the Dithyrambs of Dionysus too bore many other names before this name was settled upon. We can perhaps congratulate ourselves that "Songs of the Heights. Dedicated to all Men of the Future. By a Prophet" fell out of favour; and that the same fate befell "Dionysian Songs of a Prophet", "The Mirror of Prophecy" and "The Grave of God". Other rejected titles include "To the Higher Men. Proclamations" and "Midday and Eternity". The name of Zarathustra, Nietzsche's alter ego, appears in "The Eternal Recurrence. Zarathustra's Dances and Festivities", "The Songs of Zarathustra. Part One: The Path to Greatness" and "Zarathustra's Songs. Out of Seven Solitudes"; and it is probably a misunderstanding which has led some students of Nietzsche to suppose that the fourth part of Thus Spoke Zarathustra was at one time intended to bear the title "The Temptation of Zarathustra", since it seems [Page 15] more likely that this title too was in fact intended for the present book. Most of these titles exhibit an excessive, sometimes comic grandiloquence: yet the title Nietzsche finally affixed is, when correctly understood, more grandiloquent than any of them. A dithyramb is, in its primary meaning, a Greek choric hymn to Dionysus; by extension it comes to mean any Dionysian, or "Bacchanalian", hymn or poem. For Nietzsche, however, the word had acquired a larger meaning. In The Birth of Tragedy of 1872 he had tried to show that Greek tragedy, and thus the art of drama as such, originated in the ritual worship of Dionysus - in the dithyramb, in fact, in its original signification: the "chorus" of

Greek tragedy as we have it is, he says, the "womb of the entire so-called dialogue, i.e. the entire world of the stage, of the actual drama". He proposes that drama was born out of the dithyramb in a manner analogous to the birth of lyric out of epic poetry: in the latter case the poet, invisible in the epic, emerges from it and makes himself the centre and subject of the poem; in the former the god materializes out of the throng of his worshippers. "It is an unimpeachable tradition that Greek tragedy in its oldest form depicted only the sufferings of Dionysus", he says, but goes on to assert that "Dionysus never ceased to be the tragic hero all the famous figures of the Greek stage ... are only masks of that original hero Dionysus." It is for this reason that he alludes to the Greek tragedian as the "Dionysian dramatist", a figure whom, in Richard Wagner in Bayreuth (published in 1876), he feels entitled to call the happiest of men and the one most beneficial to other men. Later, and possibly better known formulations of what he means by a "dithyramb" are in their essence no more than a repetition of this original assertion that the dithyramb is the language in which Dionysus speaks for and of himself. To the question who "Dionysus" is there are two answers. One is that he is a Greek god, and we shall take a look at this idea of him when discussing the one poem in [Page 16] this collection in which he appears (see Notes, p. 83). The other is that he is the force of life itself and that which evolving out of it, controls it. In *The Birth of Tragedy*, Dionysus is visualized both historically; as the object of a religious cult, and as an ideogram for the "uncivilized" energies for which the Dionysian rites were a release. At this stage, the force which civilizes these energies and bestows form upon them is called Apollo, and Greek tragedy is described as Apollo's harnessing of Dionysus. But it was a description with which Nietzsche was not satisfied for very long, since, while "Dionysus" was plainly "given" as a phenomenon whose existence was unquestionable, the origin, even the possibility of "Apollo" was unexplained. Whence comes the force which constrains and employs - "civilizes" - man's animal nature? To ask the question in that way exposes the presupposition behind it that there exists a dualism in nature; and Nietzsche's dissatisfaction with *The Birth of Tragedy* was rooted finally in a realization that he had assumed this without reflecting at all deeply upon its implications. Ultimately, "nature" must mean everything that exists or it must be one element of a dualism whose other element has to be something outside and beyond nature, and that something can be thought of only as God; but if, as Nietzsche did, one comes to find the idea of God untenable, then all the effects observed in nature must be produced by nature itself: in the language of *The Birth of Tragedy*, the force which harnesses Dionysus must also be Dionysus. The concept of "sublimation" thus became a necessary and key concept in Nietzsche's monistic philosophy of "will to power": his attempt to show that all the phenomena of human life are expressions of one basic drive at various levels of

its sublimation. Within this system of thinking, "Dionysus" becomes an ideogram for sublimated will to power, and the "Dionysian man" is now a synonym for Obermensch, the man in whom will to power has been sublimated into self-mastery and self-creativity. [Page 17] The text of the Dionysos-Dithyramben printed here is that contained in the second volume of Nietzsche's Werke in drei Bänden edited by Karl Schlechta (1955). The collection was first published in 1891 together with the first public printing of Part Four of Thus Spoke Zarathustra; Schlechta's edition follows the texts reprinted in volume eight of the Gesamtausgabe in Grossoktav (1919). R. J. HOLLING DALE [Page 19] Dionysos-Dithyramben Indem ich der Menschheit eine unbegrenzte Wohltat erweisen will, gebe ich ihr meine Dithyramben. Ich Lege sie in die Hände des Dichters der Isoline, des grb}ten und ersten Satyr, der heute lebt - und nicht nur heute . . . DIONYSOS [Page 20] Dithyrambs of Dionysus In as much as I want to do mankind a boundless favour, I give them my dithyrambs. I place them in the hands of the poet of Isoline; the first and greatest satyr alive today - and not only today . . . DIONYSUS [Page 21] Nur Narr! Nur Dichter! Bei abgehellter Luft, wenn schon des Taus Trostung zur Erde niederquillt, unsichtbar, auch ungehört - denn zartes Schuhwerk trägt der Traster Tau gleich allen Trostmilden - gedenkst du da, gedenkst du, heißes Herz, wie einst du durstetest, nach himmlischen Tränen und Taugetraufel versengt und müde durstetest, dieweil auf gelben Graspfaden boshaft abendliche Sonnenblicke durch schwarze Bäume um dich liefen, blendende Sonnen-Glutblicke, schadenfrohe. "Der Wahrheit Freier - du?" so hohnten sie - "Nein! nur ein Dichter! ein Tier, ein listiges, raubendes, schleichendes, das lügen muß, das wissentlich, willentlich lügen muß, nach Beute lüestern, bunt verlarvt, such selbst zur Larve, sich selbst zur Beute, das - der Wahrheit Freier? . . . Nur Narr! nur Dichter! Nur Buntes redend, aus Narrenlarven bunt herausredend, herumsteigend auf lüernerischen Wortbrücken, auf Lügen-Regenbogen zwischen falschen Himmeln herumschweifend, herumschleichend - nur Narr! nur Dichter! . . . [Page 22] Only a Fool! Only a Poet! When the air grows clear, when the dew's comfort already rains down upon the earth, invisible and unheard - for dew the comforter wears tender shoes like all that gently comforts - do you then remember, do you, hot heart, how once you thirsted for heavenly tears and dew showers, thirsted, scorched and weary, while on yellow grassy paths wicked evening eyes of sunlight ran about you through dark trees, blinding, glowing sunlight-glances, malicious? "The wooer of truth? - you?" so they jeered "No! only a poet! an animal, cunning, preying, creeping, that has to lie, that knowingly, wilfully has to lie, lusting for prey, gaudily masked, a mask to itself, a prey to itself - that - the wooer of truth? . . . Only a fool! Only a poet! Talking only gaudy nonsense, gaudy nonsense from a fool's mask, climbing around on deceitful word-bridges, on mirage rainbows, between false skies, hovering, creeping - only a fool! only a poet! . . . [Page 23] Das - der

Wahrheit Freier? ... Nicht still, starr, glatt, kalt, zum Bilde worden, zur Gottes-Saule, nicht aufgestellt vor Tempeln, eines Gottes Tiirwart: nein! feindselig solchen Tugend-Standbildern, in jeder Wildnis heimischer als in Tempeln, voll Katzen-Mutwillens durch jedes Fenster springend husch! in jeden Zufall, jedem Urwalde zuschniiffelnd, daB du in U rwaldern unter buntzottigen Raubtieren siindlich gesund und schon und bunt lief est, mit liisternen Lefzen, selig-hohnisch, selig-hollisch, selig-blutigierig, raubend, schleichend, litgend lief est ... Oder dem Adler gleich, der lange, lange starr in Abgriinde blickt, in seine Abgriinde ... - o wie sie sich hier hinab, hinunter, hinein, · in immer tief ere Tief en ringeln ! - Dann, plotzlich, geraden Flugs, geziickten Zugs au£ Liimmer stoBen, jach hinab, heiBhungrig, nach Lammern liistern, gram allen Lamms-Seelen, grimmig gram allem, was blickt tugendhaft, schaf massig, krauswollig, dumm, mit Lammsmilch-Wohlwollen ... [Page 24] That - the wooer of truth? ... Not still, stiff, smooth, cold, become an image, become a god's statue, not set up before temples, a god's watchman: no! enemy to such statues of truth, more at home in any wilderness than in temples, full of cat's wantonness, leaping through every window, swiftly! into every chance, sniffing out every jungle, that you may run, sinfully healthy and gaudy and fair, in jungles among gaudy-speckled beasts of prey, run with lustful lips, happily jeering, happily hellish, happily blood-thirsty, preying, creeping, lying . . . Or like the eagle staring long, long into abysses, into its own abysses ... - oh how they circle down, under and in, into ever deeper depths! - Then, suddenly, with straight aim, quivering flight, they pounce on lambs, headlong down, ravenous, lusting for lambs, angry at aU lamb-souls, fiercely angry at all that looks virtuous, sheepish, curly-woolled, stupid with lamb's milk kindness ... [Page 25] Also adlerhaft, pantherhaft sind des Dichters Sehnsiichte, sind deine Sehnsiichte unter tausend Larven, du Narr! du Dichter ! . . . Der du den Menschen schautest so Gott als Schaf-, den Gott zerreißen im Menschen wie das Schaf im Menschen und zerreiBend l, o, chen - das, das ist deine Seligkeit, eines Panthers und Adlers Seligkeit, eines Dichters und Narren Seligkeit!" ... Bei abgehellter Luft, wenn schon des Monds Sichel griin zwischen Purpurroten und neidisch hinschleicht, - dem Tage feind, mit jedem Schritte heimlich an Rosen-Hiingematten hinsichelnd, bis sie sinken, nachtabwirts blaB hinabsinken: so sank ich selber einstmals aus meinem Wahrheits-Wahnsinne, aus meinen Tages-Sehnsiichten, des Tages miide, krank vom Lichte, - sank abwirts, abendwirts, schattenwirts, von einer Wahrheit verbrannt und durstig -gedenkst du noch, gedenkst du, heiBes Herz, wie da du durstetest? - daJJ ich verbannt sei von aller Wahrheit! Nur Narr! Nur Dichter! . . . [Page 26] Thus, eaglelike, pantherlike, are the poet's desires, are your de;ires under a thousand masks, you fool! you poet! . . . You who saw man as god and sheep - to rend the god in man as the sheep in man, and rending to laugh - that, that is your blessedness, a panther's and eagle's blessedness, a poet's and a fool's

blessedness!" . . . When the air grows clear, when the moon's sickle already creeps along, green, envious, in the purple twilight, - enemy to day, with every step secretly sickling down the hanging rose-gardens, until they sink, sink down, pale, down to night: so I myself sank once from my delusion of truth, from my daytime longings, weary of day, sick with light - sank downwards, down to evening, down to shadows, scorched and thirsty with one truth - do you remember, do you, hot heart, how you thirsted then? - that I am banished from all truth! Only a fool! Only a poet! . . . [Page 27] Die Wüste wiichst: weh dem, der Wusten birgt Ha! Feierlich! ein wiirdiger Anfang ! afrikanisch f eierlich ! eines Lowen wiirdig oder eines moralischen Briillaffen . . . - aber nichts fiir euch, ihr allerliebsten Freundinnen, zu deren FiiBen mir, einem Europaer unter Palmen, zu sitzen vergonnt ist. Sela. Wunderbar wahrlich! Da sitze ich nun, der Wiiste nahe und bereits so ferne wieder der Wiiste, auch in nichts noch verwiistet: namlich hinabgeschluckt von dieser kleinen Oasis - sie sperrte gerade gahnend ihr liebliches Maul auf, das wohlriechendste aller Maulchen: da fiel ich hinein, hinab, hindurch- unter euch, ihr allerliebsten Freundinnen ! Sela. Heil, Heil jenem Walfische, wenn er also es seinem Gaste wohlsein lieb ! - ihr versteht meine gelehrte Anspielung? . . . Heil seinem Bauche, wenn es also ein so lieblicher Oasis-Bauch war, [Page 28] The Desert Grows/; Woe to Him Who Harbours Deserts . . . Ha! Solemnly! a worthy beginning! solemn in an African way! worthy of a lion or of a moral screech-ape . . . - but it is not for you, you dearest maidens, at whose feet I, a European among palm-trees, am permitted to sit. Selah. Wonderful, truly! Here I now sit, beside the desert, and yet so far from the desert, and not at all devastated: for I am swallowed down by this little oasis - it simply opened, yawning, its sweetest mouth, the sweetest-smelling of all little mouths: then ffell in, down, straight through- among you, you dearest maidens! Selah. All hail to that whale if it made things so pleasant for its guest! - you understand my learned allusion? . . . All hail to its belly if it was as sweet an oasis-belly [Page 29] gleich diesem: was ich aber in Zweifel ziehe. Dafiir komme ich aus Europa, das zweifelsiichtiger ist als alle Eheweibchen. Moge Gott es bessem ! Amen. Da sitze ich nun, in dieser kleinsten Oasis, einer Dattel gleich, braun, durchsiiBt, goldschwiirig, liistem nach einem runden Madchen-Maule, mehr aber noch nach madchenhaften eiskalten schneeweiBen schneidigen BeiBzahn: nach denen niimlich lechzt das Herz allen heiBen Datteln. Sela. Den genannten Siidfriichten iihnlich, allzuihnlich liege ich hier, von kleinen Fliigelkaf em umtiinzt und umspielt, insgleichen von noch kleineren torichterem boshafteren Wiinschen und Einfuillen, - umlagert von euch, ihr stummen, ihr ahnungsvollen Miidchen-Katzen Dudu und Suleika - umsphinxst, daB ich in ein Wort viel Gefiihle stop£ e (- vergebe mir Gott diese Sprachsiinde ! . . .) - sitze hier, die beste Luft schniiffelnd, Paradiieiles-Luft wahrlich, lichte leichte Luft, goldgestreifte, so gute Luft nur je vom Monde herabfiel, sei es aus Zufall [Page

30] as this is: which, however, I call in question. Since I come from Europe, which is more sceptical than any little wife. May God improve it! Amen. Here I sit now in this smallest oasis like a date, brown, sweet, oozing golden, thirsting for a girl's rounded mouth, but thirsting more for girlish, ice-cold, snow-white, cutting teeth: for these do the hearts of all hot dates lust. Selah. Like, all too like that aforesaid southern fruit do I lie here, by little flying insects danced and played around, and by even smaller, more foolish and more wicked desires and notions - besieged by you, you silent girl-kittens full of misgivings, Dudu and Suleika - sphinxed round, that I may cram much feeling into two words: (- may God forgive me this sin of speech! . . .) - I sit here sniffing the finest air, air of Paradise, truly, bright, buoyant air, gold-streaked, as good air as ever fell from the moon - came it by chance, 3 1 [Page 31] oder geschah es aus Obermute? wie die alten Dichter erzählen. Ich Zweifler aber ziehe es in Zweifel, dafür komme ich aus Europa, das zweifelsüchtiger ist als alle Eheweibchen. Moge Gott es bessern ! Amen. Diese schönste Luft atmend, mit Niistern geschwellt gleich Bechern, ohne Zukunft, ohne Erinnerungen, so sitze ich hier, ihr allerliebsten Freundinnen, und sehe der Palme zu, wie sie, einer Tänzerin gleich, sich biegt, und schmiegt und in der Hüfte wiegt - man tut es mit, sieht man lange zu . . . einer Tänzerin gleich, die, wie mir scheinen will, zu lange schon, gefährlich lange immer, immer nur auf einem Beinchen stand? - da vergaß sie darob, wie mir scheinen will, das andre Beinchen? Vergebens wenigstens suchte ich das vermißte Zwilling-Kleinod - nämlich das andre Beinchen - in der heiligen Nähe ihres allerliebsten, allerzierlichsten Fächer- und Flatter- und Flitter-Rockchens. Ja, wenn ihr mir, ihr schönen Freundinnen, ganz glauben wollt: sie hat es verloren . . . Hu! Hu! Hu! Hu! Huh! . . . Es ist dahin, auf ewig dahin, das andre Beinchen ! O schade um dies liebliche andre Beinchen ! [Page 32] or did it happen by wantonness, as the old poets tell? I, however, call it in question, since I come from Europe, which is more sceptical than any little wife. May God improve it! Amen. Drinking in this finest air, with nostrils Swollen like goblets, without future, without memories, thus do I sit here, you dearest maidens, and regard the palm-tree, and watch how, like a dancer, it bends and bows and sways at the hips - if you watch long you follow suit . . . like a dancer who, it would seem, has stood long, dangerously long, always on one little leg? - so that she has forgotten, it would seem, the other leg? At least, in vain I sought the missing twin-jewel - that is, the other leg in the sacred vicinity of her dearest, daintiest fluttering, flickering, fan-swirling little skirt. Yes, if you would quite believe me, you sweet maids: she has lost it . . . Oh dear! oh dear! oh dear! oh dear! oh dear! It has gone, gone for ever, the other leg ! Oh, what a shame about that other dear leg! [Page 33] Wo - mag es wohl weilen und verlassen trauern, dieses einsame Beinchen? In Furcht vielleicht vor einem grimmigen gelben blondgelockten Lowen-Untiere? oder gar schon abgenagt, abgeknappert-

erbarmlich! wehe! wehe! abgeknabbert! Sela. O weint mir nicht, weiche Herzen !
 Weint mir nicht, ihr Dattel-Herzen ! Milch-Busen ! Ihr SiiBholz-Herz
 Beutelchen ! Sei ein Mann, Suleika! Mut! Mut! W eine nicht mehr, bleiche
 Dudu ! - Oder sollte vielleicht etwas Starkeres, Herz-Starkendes hier am Platze
 sein? ein gesalbter Spruch? ein feierlicher Zuspruch? . . . Ha! Herauf, Wiirde!
 Blase, blase wieder, Blasebalg der Tugend ! Ha! N och einmal briillen, moralisch
 briillen, als moralischer Lowe vor den Tochten der Wiiste briillen! - Denn
 Tugend-Geheul, ihr allerliebsten Madchen, ist mehr als alles Europaer-Inbrunst,
 Europaer-HeiBhunger ! [Page 34] Where - can it be now, sorrowing and
 forsaken, that lonely leg? Perhaps in fear before an angry, blond-maned lion-
 monster? or perhaps even gnawed off, broken in pieces - pitiable, alas! alas!
 shattered in pieces! Selah. Oh do not weep, gentle hearts! Do not weep, you date-
 hearts! milk-bosoms! You heart-caskets of sweetwood ! Be a man, Suleika!
 Courage! Courage! Weep no more, pale Dudu! - Or would perhaps something
 more bracing, heart-bracing, be in place here? an anointed proverb? a solemn
 exhortation? . . . Ha! Up, dignity! Blow, blow again, bellows of virtue ! Ha! Roar
 once again, roar morally, roar like a moral lion before the daughters of the desert!
 - For virtuous howling, you dearest maidens, is loved best of all by European
 ardour, European appetite! [Page 35] Und da stehe ich schon, als Europaer, ich
 kann nicht anders, Gott helfe mir ! Amen! Die Wiiste wachst: web dem, der
 Wiisten birgt! Stein knirscht an Stein, die Wiiste schlingt und wiirgt. Der
 ungeheure Tod blickt gliihend braun und kaut - , sein Leben ist sein Kaun . . .
 VergijJ nicht, Mensch, den Wollust ausgelobt: du - hist der Stein, die Wiiste, hist
 der Tod . . . [Page 36] And here I stand already, as European I cannot do
 otherwise, so help me God! Amen! The desert grows: woe to him who harbours
 deserts! Stone grates on stone, the desert swallows down. And death that chews,
 whose life is chewing, gazes upon it, monstrous, glowing brown . . . Consumed
 by lust, O Man, do not forget: you - are the stone, the desert, you are death . . .
 [Page 37] Letzter Wille So sterben, wie ich ihn einst sterben sah - , den Freund,
 der Blitze und Blicke gottlich in meine dunkle J ugend war£: - mutwillig und
 tie£, in der Schlacht ein Tanzer - , unter Kriegern der Heiterste, unter Siegern der
 Schwerste, auf seinem Schicksal ein Schicksal stehend, hart, nachdenklich,
 vordenklich- : erzitternd darob, daB er siegte, jauchzend dariiber, daB er sterbend
 siegte - : befehlend, indem er starb, - und er befahl, daB man vernichte . . . So
 sterben, wie ich ihn einst sterben sah: siegend, vernichtend . . . [Page 38] Last
 Will . So to die as once I saw him die - the friend who like a god cast glances of
 lightning into my dark youth: - wanton, profound, in the slaughter a dancer - of
 fighters the cheerfulest, of victors the most difficult, a destiny standing upon his
 destiny, firm, reflecting, prelecting - : trembling with joy of victory, rejoicing
 that he died in victory: by dying, commanding - and he commanded
 destruction . . . So to die as once I saw him die: victorious, destroying . . . [Page

39] Zwischen Raubvögeln Wer hier hinab will, wie schnell schluckt den die Tiefe ! - Aber du, Zarathustra, liebst den Abgrund noch, tust der Tanne es gleich? - Die schlägt Wurzeln, wo der Fels selbst schauernd zur Tiefe blickt -, die zögert an Abgründen, wo alles rings hinunter will: zwischen der Ungeduld wilden Gerölls, stürzenden Bachs geduldig duldend, hart, schweigsam, einsam . . . Einsam! Wer wagte es auch, hier zu Gast zu sein, dir Gast zu sein? . . . Ein Raubvogel vielleicht, der hängt sich wohl dem standhaften Dulder schadenfroh ins Haar, mit irrem Geliichter, einem Raubvogel-Geliichter . . . Wozu so standhaft? - höhnt er grausam: man muß Flügel haben, wenn man den Abgrund liebt . man muß nicht hängen bleiben, wie, du, Gehängter! - [Page 40] Amid Birds of Prey He who descends here how soon the depths devour him! - But you, Zarathustra, you love the abyss, as the fir-tree does? - It strikes roots where the cliff itself shudders when it looks below - it lingers at abysses where everything wants to plunge down: amid the impatience of savage rocks and precipitate streams calmly forbearing, hard, silent, solitary . . . Solitary! But who would dare to visit here, to visit you? . . . A bird of prey perhaps, he might hang, with crazy laughter, a bird of prey's laughter, malicious, in the patient stoic's hair . . . Why so steadfast? - he cruelly mocks: if you love abysses you must have wings . . . and not just hang there, as you do, hanged man! - [Page 41] O Zarathustra, grausamster Nimrod! Jüngst Jäger noch Gottes, das Fangnetz aller Tugend, der Pfeil des Bösen! - Jetzt- von dir selber erjagt, deine eigene Beute, in dich selber eingebohrt . . . Jetzt- einsam mit dir, zwiesam im eignen Wissen, zwischen hundert Spiegeln vor dir selbstdalsch, zwischen hundert Erinnerungen ungewiß, an jeder Wunde mild, an jedem Froste kalt, in eignen Stricken gewürgt, Selbstkenner I Selbstkenner I Was bandest du dich mit dem Strick deiner Weisheit? Was locktest du dich ins Paradies der alten Schlange? Was schlichst du dich ein in dich - in dich? . . . Ein Kranker nun, der an Schlangengift krank ist; ein Gefanger nun, der das harteste Los zog: im eignen Schachte gebückt arbeitend, in dich selber eingehohlt, dich selber angrabend, [Page 42] O Zarathustra, cruellest Nimrod! Lately God's huntsman, net to net all virtue, arrow of the wicked! - Now- hunted down by yourself, your own booty, burrowed into yourself . . . Now- alone with yourself, twofold in self-knowledge, amid a hundred mirrors false before yourself, amid a hundred memories uncertain, wearied by every wound, frozen by every frost, choked in your own net, self-knower I self-hangman! Why did you trap yourself in your wisdom? Why did you lure yourself into the old serpent's garden? why did you creep into yourself? . . . Sick now of the serpent's poison; a prisoner now with the hardest fate: labouring bowed.. In your own mine, self-excavated, digging into yourself, [Page 43] unbehilflich, steif, ein Leichnam -, von hundert Lasten überlastet, von dir überlastet, ein Wissender! ein Selbstkenner ! der weise Zarathustra ! . . . Du suchtest die schwerste Last: da fandest du dich - du wirfst dich nicht ab von

dir . . . Lauernd, kauernnd, einer, der schon nicht mehr aufrecht steht ! Du
 verwachst mir noch mit deinem Grabe, verwachsener Geist! . . . Und jingst noch
 so stolz, auf allen Stelzen deines Stolzes ! Jjingst noch der Einsiedler ohne Gott,
 der Zweisiedler mit dem Teufel, der scharlachne Prinz jedes Übermuts ! . . .
 Jetzt- zwischen zwei Nichtse eingekriimmt, ein Fragezeichen, ein miides Ratsel -
 ein Ratsel für Raubvogel . . . - sie werden dich schon "losen", sie hungern schon
 nach deiner "Losung", sie flattern schon um dich, ihr Ratsel, um dich,
 Gehenkter! . . . 0 Zarathustra! . . . Selbstkenner! . . . Selbsthenker! . . . [Page 44]
 awkward, stiff, a corpse- overtowered by a hundred burdens, overburdened with
 yourself, a man of knowledge who knows himself! the wise Zarathustra ! . . . You
 sought the heaviest burdens and you found yourself- it is a burden you cannot
 throw off . . . Lying in wait, crouching, one who is no longer upright! In form
 like your own grave, deformed spirit! . . . And lately still so proud, still on the
 stilts of your pride! Lately still the godless hermit, the dweller with the devil, the
 high haughty scarlet prince! . . . Now- contorted between two nothings, a
 question-mark, a weary riddle - a riddle for birds of prey . . . - they will soon
 "resolve" you, already they thirst for your "resolution", already they flutter about
 you, their riddle, about you, hanged man! . . . 0 Zarathustra! . . . Self-knower! . . .
 Self-hangman! . . . [Page 45] Das Feuerzeichen Hier, wo zwischen Meeren die
 Insel wuchs, ein Opferstein jiih hinaufgetiirmt, hier ziindet sich unter schwarzem
 Himmel Zarathustra seine Hohenfeuer an, - Feuerzeichen für verschlagene Schiffe
 er, Fragezeichen für solche, die Antwort haben ... Diese Flamme mit
 weißgrauem Bauche - in kalte Feuerne ziingelt ihre Gier, nach immer reineren
 Rohen biegt sie den Hals - eine Schlange gerade aufgerichtet vor Ungeduld:
 dieses Zeichen stellte ich vor mich hin. Meine Seele selber ist diese Flamme:
 unersättlich nach neuen Feuerne lodert aufwärts, aufwärts ihre stille Glut. Was
 floh Zarathustra vor Tier und Menschen? Was entlief er jiih allem festen Lande?
 Sechs Einsamkeiten kennt er schon - , aber das Meer selbst war nicht genug ihm
 einsam, die Insel lieb ihn steigen, auf dem Berg wurde er zur Flamme, nach
 einer siebenten Einsamkeit wirft er suchend jetzt die Angel über sein Haupt. Ver-
 erschlagene Schiffe er! Triimmer alter Sterne ! Ihr Meere der Zukunft!
 Unausgeforschte Himmel! nach allem Einsamen werfe ich jetzt die Angel: gebt
 Antwort auf die Ungeduld der Flamme, fangt mir, dem Fischer auf hohen
 Bergen, meine. siebente, letzte Einsamkeit!-- [Page 46] The Fire-Signal Here,
 where amid seas the island rose, a steeply towering sacrificial stone, here beneath
 a black sky Zarathustra lit for himself his mountain fire - a fire-signal for seamen
 blown off course, a question-mark for those who possess answers ... This flame
 with light-grey belly - its eager tongue flicking the chill horizon, its neck arched
 out to ever purer heights - a snake raised upright with impatience: this signal I set
 up before me. My soul, my soul itself, is this flame: insatiable for new horizons
 its silent glowing passion blazes upward. Why did Zarathustra flee from beasts

and men? Why did he flee from all firm land? Six solitudes he knew already - but the sea itself had too little solitude for him, the island welcomed him, and on the 11}.OU!).tain he became a flame, and when now he whirls his fishing-line it is a seventh solitude he seeks to catch .. Seamen blown off course! Rubble of old stars! You seas of the future! Unexplored sky ! to all that knows solitude do I now throw this line: give answer to the flame's impatience, catch me, the fisherman on high mountains, my seventh, final solitude! - - [Page 47] Die Sonne sinkt I Nicht lange durstest du noch, verbranntes Herz! Verheißung ist in der Luft, aus unbekannten Mündern bläst mich's an, - die große Kühle kommt . . . Meine Sonne stand heiß über mir im Mittage: seid mir gegrißt, daß ihr kommt, ihr plotzlichen Winde, ihr kühlen Geister des Nachmittags ! Die Luft geht fremd und rein. Schielt nicht mit schiefem Verführerblick die Nacht mich an? . . . Bleib stark, mein tapfres Herz! Frag nicht: warum? Tag meines Lebens! die Sonne sinkt. Schon steht die glatte Flut vergilbet. Warm atmet der Fels: schlief wohl zu Mittag das Glück auf ihm seinen Mittagsschlaf? In grünen Lichtern spielt Glück noch der braune Abgrund herauf. [Page 48] The Sun Sinks I You shall not thirst much longer, scorched heart! A promise is in the air, from mouths unknown it wafts to me - great coolness comes . . . My sun stood hot above me at midday: welcome, sudden winds, now you have come, cool spirits of the afternoon! The air grows strange and clean. Does night not look at me with sidelong seductive eyes? . . . Stay strong, brave heart! Do not ask why. - Day of my life! the sun sinks. Already the smooth flood stands gilded. The cliffs breathe warmth: did happiness at midday sleep there its midday sleep? From the brown abyss light and green it still dazzles up. [Page 49] Tag meines Lebens! gen Abend geht! Schon gliht dein Auge halbgebrochen, schon quillt deines Taues Tranengetraufel, schon läuft still über weiße Meere deiner Liebe Purpur, deine letzte zögernde Seligkeit. Heiterkeit, gildene, komm! du des Todes heimlichster, süßester Vergnügen ! - Lief ich zu rasch meines Wegs? Jetzt erst, wo der Fuß müde ward, holt dein Blick mich noch ein, holt dein Glück mich noch ein. Rings nur Welle und Spiel. Was je schwer war, sank in blaue Vergessenheit - müde steht nun mein Kahn, Sturm und Fahrt - wie verlernt er das ! Wunsch und Hoffen ertrank, glatt liegt Seele und Meer. Siebente Einsamkeit ! Nie empfand ich näher mir süße Sicherheit, warmer der Sonne Blick. - Gliht nicht das Eis meiner Gipfel noch? Silbern, leicht, ein Fisch schwimmt nun mein Nachen hinaus . . . [Page 50] Day of my life! it is almost evening! Already the glow of your eye is half-dimmed, already the tears of your dew are falling, already there runs softly on the white sea your love's purple, your final hesitating bliss. Gilded cheerfulness, come! sweetest, secretest foretaste of death! - Did I run my course too quickly? Only now, when my foot has grown weary, does your glance overtake me, does your happiness overtake me. Only playing of waves all around. Whatever was hard has sunk into blue oblivion - my boat now lies idle. Storm and voyaging -all

forgotten now! Desire and hope have drowned, smooth lie soul and sea. Seventh
 solitude! Never such sweet security, never such sunlight warmth. - Does the ice
 of my summit still glow? Silver, light, a fish my little craft now swims out ...
 [Page 51] Klage der Ariadne Wer warmt mich, wer liebt mich noch? Gebt heiBe
 Hande ! gebt Herzens-Kohlenbecken ! Hingestreckt, schauernd, Halbtotem
 gleich, dem man die FiBe warmt, geschiittelt ach ! von unbekannten Fiebern,
 zitternd vor spitzen eisigen Frostpfeilen, von dir gejagt, Gedanke ! U
 nnennbal" h ! V erhiillter, Entsetzlicher ! Du Jager hinter Wolken!
 Darniedergeblitzt von dir, du hohnisch Auge, das mich aus Dunklem anblickt !
 So liege ich, biege mich, winde mich, gequalt von allen ewigen Martern,
 getroffen von dir, grausamster Jager, du unbekannter - Gott . . . Triff tie£ er! Triff
 einmal noch ! Zerstich, zerstich dies Herz! Was soll dies Martern mit
 zahnestumpf en Pf eilen? Was blickst du wieder, der Menschen-Qual nicht miide,
 mit schadenfrohen Gotter-Blitz-Augen? Nicht toten willst du, nur martern,
 martern? Wozu - mich martern, du schadenfroher unbekannter Gott? Haha! du
 schleichst heran bei solcher Mitternacht? . . . [Page 52] Ariadne's C omplint
 Who still warms me, who still loves me? Off er me hot hands! offer me coal-
 warmers for the heart! Spread-eagled, shuddering, like one half-dead whose feet
 are warmed - shaken, alas ! by unknown fevers, trembling with sharp icy frost-
 arrows, pursued by you, my thought! Unutterable, veiled, terrible one !
 Huntsman behind the clouds! Struck down by your lightning-bolt, you mocking
 eye that stares at me from the darkness ! Thus I lie, bend myself, twist myself,
 tortured by every eternal torment, smitten by you, cruel huntsman, you unknown
 -god .. Strike deeper! Strike once again ! Sting and sting, shatter this heart t
 What means this torment with blunt arrows? Why do you look down, unwearied
 of human pain, with malicious divine flashing eyes? Will you not kill, only
 torment, torment? Why - torment me, you malicious, unknown god? Ha ha! Are
 you stealing near at such a midnight hour? ... [Page 53] Was willst du? Sprich!
 Du drangst mich, driickst mich, Ha! schon viel zu nahe ! Du horst mich atmen,
 du behorchst mein Herz, du Eifersiichtiger ! - worauf doch eifersiichtig? Weg!
 Weg! wozu die Leiter? willst du hinein, ins Herz, einsteigen, in meine
 heimlichsten Gedanken einsteigen? Schamloser ! U nbekannter ! Dieb ! Was
 willst du dir erstehlen? Was willst du dir erhochen? Was willst du dir erfoltern,
 du Folterer du - Renker-Gott! Oder soll ich, dem Hunde gleich, vor dir mich
 walzen? Hingebend, begeistert auBer mir dir Liebe - zuwedeln? Umsonst ! Stich
 weiter ! Grausamster Stachel ! Kein Hund- dein Wild nur bin ich, grausamster
 Jager! deine stolzeste Gefagne; du Rauber hinter Wolken . . . Sprich endlich ! Du
 Blitz-Verhiillter ! U nbekannter ! sprich ! Was willst du, Wegelagerer, von -
 mir? . . . Wie? Losegeld? [Page 54] What do you want? Speak! You oppress me,
 press me, Ha! far too closely! You hear me breathing, you overhear my heart,
 you jealous god! - yet jealous of what? Away! Away! Why the ladder? Would you

climb into my heart, climb into my most secret thoughts? Shameless, unknown thief! What would you get by stealing? What would you get by listening? What would you get by torturing, you torturer? you - hangman-god! Or shall I, like a dog, roll before you? Surrendering, raving with rapture, wag - love to you? In vain! Strike again, cruellest goad ! Not dog- I am only your game, cruellest huntsman! your proudest prisoner, you robber behind the clouds . . . For the last time, speak! Veiled in lightning! Unknown! speak! What do you want, way layer, from - .ne? What? Ransom? [Page 55] Was willst du Losegelds? Verlange viel - das rat mein Stolz! und rede kurz - das rat mein andrer Stolz! . Haha! Mich-willst du? mich? mich- ganz? ... Haha! Und marterst mich, Narr, der du hist, zermarterst meinen Stolz? Gib Liebe mir - wer warmt mich noch? wer liebt mich noch? gib heie Hande, gib Herzens-Kohlenbecken, gib mir, der Einsamsten, die Eis, ach ! siebenfaches Eis nach Feinden selber, nach Feinden schmachten lehrt, gib, ja ergib, grausamster Feind, mir- dich! ... Davon! Da floh er selber, mein einziger Geno, mein groer Feind, mein U nbekannter, mein Henker-Gott! ... Nein! komm zuriick! Mit allen deinen Martern ! All meine Tranen laufen zu dir den Lauf und meine letzte Herzensflamme dir gliiht sie auf. O komm zuriick, mein unbekannter Gott! mein Schmerz! mein letztes Gliick! ... [Page 56] How much ransom? Demand much - thus speaks my pride! and be brief - thus speaks my other pride! Ha! ha! Me - you want me? me - all of me? . . . Ha ha! And you torment me, fool that you are, you rack my pride? Offer me love - who still warms me? who still loves me? offer me hot hands, offer me coal-warmers for the heart, offer me, the most solitary, whom ice, alas! sevenfold ice has taught to long for enemies, even for enemies, offer, yes yield to me, cruellest enemy - yourself! . . . He is gone ! He has fled, my sole companion, my great enemy, my unknown, my hangman-god! . . . No! come back! with all your torments! All the streams of my tears run their course to you! and the last flame of my heart, it burns up to you. Oh come back, my unknown god! my pain! my last happiness! . . . [Page 57] Ein Blitz. Dionysos wird in smaragdener Schonheit sichtbar. DIONYSOS : Sei klug, Ariadne! . . . Du hast kleine Ohren, du hast meine Ohren: steck ein kluges Wort hinein ! - MuB man sich nicht erst hassen, wenn man sich lieben soll? . . . !eh bin dein Labyrinth . . . [Page 58] A flash of lightning. Dionysus becomes, visible in emerald beauty. · DIONYSUS : Be wise, Ariadne! . . . You have little ears; you have ears like mine: let some wisdom into them! - Must we not first hate ourself if we are to love ourself? . . . I am thy labyrinth . . . [Page 59] Ruhm und Ewigkeit I Wie lange sitztest du schon auf deinem MiBgeschick? Gib acht! du brütest mir noch ein Ei, ein Basilisken-Ei aus deinem langen Jammer aus. Was schleicht Zarathustra entlang dem Berge? - MiBtrauisch, geschwiirig, duster, ein langer Lauerer - , aber plotzlich, ein Blitz, hell, furchtbar, ein Schlag gen Himmel aus dem Abgrund: - dem Berge selber schiittelt sich das Eingeweide . . . Wo HaB und Blitzstrahl Eins ward, ein Fluch

- , auf den Bergen haust jetzt Zarathustras Zorn, eine Wetterwolke schleicht er seines Wegs. Verkrieche sich, wer eine letzte Decke hat! Ins Bett mit euch, ihr Zartlinge ! Nun rollen Donner iiber die Gewolbe, nun zittert, was Gebalk und Mauer ist, nun zucken Blitze und schwefelgelbe Wahrheiten - Zarathustraflucht . . . [Page 60] Fame and Eternity I How long have you already brooded upon your misfortune? Take care! you will yet hatch an egg, a basilisk egg, out of your protracted misery. Why does Zarathustra slink along beside the mountain? Mistrustful, ulcerous, gloomy, long lying in wait - then suddenly, a lightning-flash, bright, fearful, a blow towards the sky from the abyss: - the mountain itself feels its intestines shake . . . Where hate and lightning became one, a curse - on the mountains Zarathustra's wrath now makes its home, slinks along its path a thundercloud. Whoever has a shelter, let him seek it! Away with you to bed, you weak,lings! Now thunders roll over the vaulted roofs, now trembles what is wall and timber-work, now lightnings flash and brimstone-coloured truths - Zarathustra curses . . . [Page 61] Diese Miinze, mit der alle Welt bezahlt, Ruhm - , mit Handschuhen fasse ich diese Miinze an, mit Ekel trete ich sie unter mich. Wer will bezahlt sein? Die Kauflichen . . . Wer feil steht, greift mit fetten Handen nach diesem Allerwelts-Blechklingklang Ruhm! - Willst du sie kaufen? Sie sind alle kauflich. Aber biete viel ! klinge mit vollem Beutel! - du starkst sie sonst, du starkst sonst ihre Tugend . . . Sie sind alle tugendhaft. Ruhm und Tugend- das reimt sich. So lange die Welt lebt, zahlt sie Tugend-Geplapper mit Ruhm-Geklapper - , die Welt lebt von diesem Larm . . . Vor allen Tugendhaften will ich schuldig sein, schuldig heiBen mit jeder groBen Schuld! Vor allen Ruhms-Schalltrichtern wird mein Ehrgeiz zum Wurm - , unter solchen geliistets mich, der Niedrigste zu sein . . . [Page 62] This coin with which all the world makes payment, Jame- I grasp this coin with gloves, with loathing I trample it beneath me. Who wants to be paid? The buyable . . . He who is for sale reaches with greasy hands for this everybodys-jingling-tinpot fame! - Do you want to buy them? They are all buyable. But off er much! jingle a full purse! - or you will fortijy them, you will fortify their virtue . . . They are all virtuous. Fame and virtue - they go together. For as long as the world lives it pays chatter of virtue with clatter of fame - the world lives by this racket . . . To all the virtuous I want to be in debt, of every great offence called guilty! Before all bell-mouths of fame my ambition becomes a worm - of such I desire to be the lowest . . . [Page 63] Diese Miinze, mit der alle Welt bezahlt, Ruhm - , mit Handschuhen fasse ich diese Miinze an, mit Ekel trete ich sie unter mich. Still! - Von groBen Dingen - ich sehe GroBes ! - soll man schweigen oder groB reden: rede groB, meine entziickte Weisheit! Ich sehe hinauf - dort rollen Lichtmeere : o Nacht, o Schweigen, o totenstiller Liirm! . . . Ich sehe ein Zeichen - , aus fernsten Fernen sinkt langsam funkelnd ein Sternbild gegen mich . . . Hochstes Gestirn des Seins ! Ewiger Bildwerke Tafel ! Du kommst zu mir? - Was keiner erschaut hat,

deine stumme Schonheit - wie? sie flieht vor meinen Blicken nicht? - Schild der Notwendigkeit ! Ewiger Bildwerke Tafel ! - aber du weißt es ja ! was alle hassen, was allein ich liebe: 6.4 [Page 64] This coin with which all the world makes payment, I grasp this coin with gloves, with loathing I trample it beneath me. Soft!- Of great things - I see something great! - one should keep silent or speak greatly: speak greatly, my enraptured wisdom! I look above me - there seas of light are rolling: oh night, oh silence, oh deathly silent uproar! . . . I see a sign- from the farthest distance · slowly glittering a constellation sinks towards me . . . Highest star of being! Eternal tablet of forms! You come to me? - What none has beheld, your speechless beauty- what? it flees not from my gaze?- Image of what must be! Eternal tablet of forms! - but you know it: what everyone else hates, what I alone love: [Page 65] - daß du ewig bist ! daß du notwendig bist ! - meine Liebe entzündet sich ewig nur an der Notwendigkeit. Schild der Notwendigkeit! Höchstes Gestirn des Seins ! - das kein Wunsch erreicht, - das kein Nein befleckt, ewiges Ja des Seins, ewig bin ich dein Ja: denn ich liebe dich, o Ewigkeit! - - [Page 66] - that you are eternal! that you must be I - my love is ignited only by that which must be. Image of what must be! Highest star of being! - what no longing attains - no denial defiles, eternal Yes of being, eternally am I thy Yes: for I love thee, O eternity! - - [Page 67] Von der Armut des Reichsten Zehn Jahre dahin - , kein Tropfen erreichte mich, kein feuchter Wind, kein Tau der Liebe - ein regenloses Land . . . Nun bitte ich meine Weisheit, nicht geizig zu werden in dieser Durre: strome selber über, traufle selber Tau, sei selber Regen der vergilbten Wildnis ! Einst hieß ich die Wolken fortgehen von meinen Bergen, - einst sprach ich "mehr Licht, ihr Dunklen!" Heut locke ich sie, daß sie kommen: macht Dunkel um mich mit euren Eutern! - ich will euch melken, ihr Kuhe der Höhe! Milchwarme Weisheit, süßen Tau der Liebe strome ich über das Land. Fort, fort, ihr Wahrheiten, die ihr duster blickt! Nicht will ich auf meinen Bergen herbe ungeduldige Wahrheiten sehn. Vom Lächeln vergiildet nahe mir heut die Wahrheit, von der Sonne gesüßt, von der Liebe gebräunt, - eine reife Wahrheit breche ich allein vom Baum. Heut strecke ich die Hand aus nach den Locken des Zufalls, klug genug, den Zufall einem Kinde gleich zu führen, zu überlisten. Heut will ich gastfreundlich sein gegen Unwillkommnes, [Page 68] Of the Poverty of the Richest Man Ten years have passed - no drop of water has reached me, no moist wind, no dew of love - a rainless land . . . Now I ask of my wisdom that it grow not mean in this aridity: yourself overflow, yourself drop dew, yourself be rain to this yellowed wilderness! Once I bade the clouds depart my mountains - once I said "more light, dark clouds!" Today I lure them to come back: make darkness round me with your udders! - I want to milk you, cows of the heights! Milkwarm wisdom, secret dew of love I pour down over the land. Be gone, be gone, truths of gloomy aspect! I want on my mountain no acid fretful truths. Golden with smiles let truth approach me today, made

sweet by the sun, made brown by love, ripe truths alone do I pluck from the vine. Today I stretched out my hand to the hairy head of chance, cunning enough to outwit chance and lead it along like a child. Today I will be hospitable to things unwelcome, [Page 69] gegen das Schicksal selbst will ich nicht stachlicht sein, - Zarathustra ist kein Igel. Meine Seele, unersättlich mit ihrer Zunge, . an alle guten und schlimmen Dinge hat sie schon geleck, in jede Tiefe tauchte sie hinab. Aber immer gleich dem Korke, immer schwimmt sie wieder obenauf, sie gaukelt wie 61 iiber braune Meere: dieser Seele halber heiBt man mich den Glicklichen. Wer sind mir Vater und Mutter? Ist nicht mir Vater Prmz Überfluß und Mutter das stille Lachen? Erzeugte nicht dieser beiden Ehebund mich Ratseltier, mich Lichtunhold, mich Verschwender aller Weisheit, Zarathustra? Krank heute vor Zartlichkeit, ein Tauwind, sitzt Zarathustra wartend, wartend auf seinen Bergen, - im eignen Saft siiiB geworden und gekocht, unterhalb seines Gipfels, unterhalb seines Eises, miid und selig, ein Schaff ender an seinem siebenten Tag. - Still! Eine Wahrheit wandelt iiber mir einer Wolke gleich, - mit unsichtbaren Blitzen trifft sie mich. Auf breiten langsamen Treppen steigt ihr Gluck zu mir: komm, komm, geliebte Wahrheit! [Page 70] towards fate itself I will not be prickly - Zarathustra is no hedgehog. My soul, its tongue insatiable, has licked at every good and evil thing, dived down into every depth. But always, like a cork, always it comes bobbing up again, it juggles like oil on the brown surf ace of the sea: on account of this my soul they call me: the happy man. Who are my father and mother? Is my father not Prince Abundance and my mother a silent laughter? Did the marriage of this couple not engender this enigmatic beast, this demon of light, this squanderer of wisdom, Zarathustra? Sick today with tenderness, a thawing wind, Zarathustra sits waiting, waiting in his mountains - in his own juice cooked and grown sweet, below his summit, below his ice, tired and happy, a creator on his seventh day. - Soft! A truth passes over me like a cloud - strikes me with invisible lightnings. On broad slow stairways its happiness climbs up to me: come, come, beloved truth! [Page 71] - Still! Meine Wahrheit ist! - Aus zogernden Augen, aus samtenen Schauern trifft mich ihr Blick, lieblich, hos, ein Madchenblick . . . Sie erriet meinen Glickes Grund, sie erriet mich - ha! was sinnt sie aus? - Purpurn lauert ein Drache im Abgrunde ihres Madchenblicks. - Still! Meine Wahreit redet! Wehe dir, Zarathustra! Du siehst aus, wie einer, der Gold verschluckt hat: man wird dir noch den Bauch aufschlitzen ! . . . Zu reich hist du, du Verderber vieler ! Zu viele machst du neidisch, zu viele m:achst du arm . . . Mir selber wirft dein Licht Schatten - , es frostelt mich: geh weg, du Reicher, geh, Zarathustra, weg aus deiner Sonne! . . . Du mochtest schenken, wegschenken deinen Überfluß, aber du selber hist der Überfliissigste ! Sei klug, du Reicher! Verschenke dich selber erst, o Zarathustra! Zehn Jahre dahin - , und kein Tropfen erreichte dich? kein feuchter Wind? kein Tau der Liebe? Aber wer sollte dich auch lieben, du Überreicher? [Page 72] - Soft! It is my truth! - From

hesitant eyes, from velvet tremblings its glance strikes at me, lovely, wicked, the glance of a girl . . . She divines the ground of my happiness, she divines me - ha! what is she thinking of? Purple there lurks a dragon in the abyss of her glance. - Soft! My truth speaks! - Woe to thee, ... Zarathustra! You resemble one who has swallowed gold: you will yet have your belly cut open! . . . You are too rich, corrupter of many! You make too many envious, you make too many poor . . . Even I am cast in shadow by your light - I grow cold: away, man gifted with riches, away, Zarathustra, out of your sunlight! . . . You would like to bestow, to give away your superfluity, but you yourself are the most superfluous! Be sensible, man gifted with riches! First give yourself, O Zarathustra ! Ten years have passed - and no drop of water has reached you? no moist wind? no dew of love? But who could love you, man superabundant in riches? [Page 73] Dein Glück macht rings trocken, macht arm an Liebe - ein regenloses Land ... Niemand dankt dir mehr. Du aber dankst jedem, der von dir nimmt: daran erkenne ich dich, du Überreicher, du Armster aller Reichen ! Du opferst dich, dich quillt dein Reichtum - , du gibst dich ah, du schonst dich nicht, du liebst dich nicht: die große Qual zwingt dich allezeit, die Qual übervoller Scheuern, übervollen Herzens - aber niemand dankt dir mehr ... Du mußt armer werden, weiser Unweiser ! willst du geliebt sein. Man liebt nur die Leidenden, man gibt Liebe nur dem Hungernden: verschenke dich selbst erst, o Zarathustra! - Ich bin deine Wahrheit ... [Page 74] Your happiness makes all around you arid, makes it poor in love - a rainless land . . . No one thanks you now. But you thank everyone who takes from you: that is how I know you, superabundant in riches, poorest of all the rich! You offer yourself, your riches torment you ,... you deliver yourself up, you do not spare yourself, do not love yourself: the great torment constrains you always, the torment of barns overfull, of a heart overfull - but no one thanks you now . . . You must grow poorer, unwise man of wisdom! if you want to be loved. Only the suffering are loved, love is given only to the hungry man: first give yourself, O Zarathustra ! - I am thy truth . . . 7S [Page 76] Notes The following notes are mainly biographical and seek to place the poems in the context of Nietzsche's life and works. Only a Fool! Only a Poet! (page 23) This opening poem was first printed, in a slightly different version, in the fourth part of Thus Spoke Zarathustra (1885), where it is included in the chapter called "The Song of Melancholy" and put into the mouth of "the old sorcerer". The action of Zarathustra Part Four involves the appearance in Zarathustra's remote mountainous territory of a number of "higher men" whose specific errors and shortcomings are revealed to them during their brief sojourn there. Among them is "the old sorcerer", and it is universally agreed that he is Richard Wagner and thus, by an extension very amply documented in Nietzsche's other writings, the epitome of "the artist". Now, for reasons which should become clear when we come to discuss the following poem, I would contend that the three Dithyrambs

of Dionysus included in the fourth part of Zarathustra were inserted there capriciously and by force - that is, that they were originally composed independently of Zarathustra and do not truly belong in that book. In this present instance, however, little argumentation is called for: if, as seems to be obviously the case, "Zarathustra" is Nietzsche's ideal self, the "higher men" are, as well as being other identifiable individuals or types, also facets of Nietzsche's own character of which he at least in part disapproves, repudiates and, in the visionary conclusion of TBus Spoke Zarathustra, overcomes; the one rep resented by the sorcerer, Wagner, is Nietzsche as artist, and in this poem specifically as poet, and the poem thus rightly belongs at the head of the present collection of poems. In the chapter of Zarathustra called "Of Poets", Zarathustra is asked why he once said that the poets lie too [Page 77] much: he replies: "What did Zarathustra once say to you? That the poets lie too much? - But Zarathustra too is a poet. Do you now believe that he spoke the truth? Why do you believe it?" Granted, however, he goes on, that "someone has said in all seriousness that the poets lie too much: he is right - we do lie too much. We know too little and are bad learners: so we have to lie." The Desert Grows: Woe to Him Who Harbours Deserts . . . (page 29) This poem too was inserted, in a form only slightly different from that in which it appears here, in Part Four of Thus Spoke Zarathustra. There it is placed in the mouth of "the wanderer who called himself Zarathustra's shadow". and who is usually regarded as representing the "freethinker". It constitutes the greater part of the chapter called " Among the Daughters of the Desert". The "higher men" have just been treated by Zarathustra to a banquet and the sorcerer has, by way of postprandial entertain ment, spoiled the prevailing spirit of gaiety with a recital of "Only a fool! Only a poet!" It is in response to this, and with the intention of restoring his fell ow guests' good humour, that the shadow sings them his poem "The desert grows". - "I have seen many lands", he says in preamble, "my nose has learned to test and appraise many kinds of air: but with you my nostrils taste their greatest delight! Except, except -oh forgive an old memory! Forgive me an old after-dinner song that I once composed among the daughters of the desert - for with them there was the same good, clear oriental air; there I was furthest away from cloudy, damp, melancholy Old Europe! In those days I loved such oriental girls and other blue kingdoms of heaven, over which no clouds and no thoughts hung. You would not believe how prettily they sat there when they were not dancing, deep but without thoughts, like little secrets, like ribboned riddles, like after-dinner nuts - motley and strange indeed! but without clouds: riddles that one can read: to please such girls I then devised an after-dinner psalm." [Page 78] Whereupon he sings his song "wi th a kind of roaring". Now even in the context of the fourth part of Zarathustra, whose action is so structured that almost anything could take place, this poem seems an irrelevance and a capricious insert: even more obviously than "Only a Fool! Only

a Poet!" it originates outside the Zarathustra-world and is a piece of pure autobiography. H. W. Brann was, so far as I know, the first to assert in print that it is a lightly disguised recollection of a visit to a brothel (in *Nietzsche und die Frauen*, I 93 1). The evidence for this assertion seems to me compelling and the interpretation plainly correct. The poem itself, with its setting and near doubles entendres, can easily be interpreted in this sense without strain and regardless of who wrote it: so nearly unequivocal is it, indeed, that one would almost have to prove that this interpretation was not correct. Knowing it is by Nietzsche, however, we can also draw on evidence extraneous to it. In the most general sense it can be said that, since he was a student at two German universities in the 1860s and 1870s, it would not be in any way unusual if he had visited a brothel, at any rate once: it was a normal student practice. And it happens that we have an account, almost certainly in his own words, of an occasion when he was taken to one. It is contained in the recollections of a fellow student, the philologist Paul Deussen, published in 1901. In February 1865 both were students at Bonn, and Nietzsche told him, Deussen says, that he had paid a visit to Cologne, where a cab driver had driven him around and when he finally asked to be taken to a good restaurant the driver had transported him to a brothel instead. "I suddenly saw myself surrounded by half-a-dozen apparitions in tinsel and gauze, who looked at me expectantly", Nietzsche told him. "I stood for a moment speechless. Then I made for a piano in the room as to the only living thing in that company and struck several chords. They broke the spell and I hurried away." This brief passage in Deussen's *Erinnerungen an Friedrich Nietzsche* has created a small literature of its own, culminating in Thomas [Page 79] Mann's *Doctor Faustus*, since it is the only concrete piece of evidence we have which links Nietzsche's mental and physical breakdown with what must almost certainly have been its cause. There can be very little doubt by now, when every aspect and almost every week of Nietzsche's life have been scrutinized from every possible angle, that the illness he suffered from was syphilis (which in his day was incurable) or that, in the total absence of any evidence to the contrary, he contracted it from a prostitute. It has been shown that he was treated for a syphilitic infection by two doctors in Leipzig during 1867; and there is much in his singular and tragic existence that is explicable only by supposing he knew, or strongly suspected, what his "illness" actually was (though almost certainly he failed to realize what the full extent of its consequences would be). That "The Desert Grows . . ." should be included in this ultimate production of Nietzsche's literary genius is thus in the most hideous sense appropriate. Last Will (page 39) This is probably the earliest of the Dithyrambs of Dionysus: it appears in a notebook of 1883 which also contains notes for Part Three of Zarathustra. I am unable to say who the dying man is, or even to suggest a candidate: notwithstanding that 1883 is the year of Wagner's death, it is certainly not him. Possibly the figure is

imaginary; for there seem to be clear links between "Last Will" and one of the best-known chapters of Zarathustra, "Of Voluntary Death", the burden of which is that one should "die at the right time" so that one's death will be "a spur and a promise to the living". Amid Birds of Prey (page 41) At first entitled "Am Abgrunde" ("At the Abyss"), "Zwis chen Raubvogeln" is the harshest of Nietzsche's many hymns to solitude. One of the soundest reasons for iden- [Page 80] tifying Nietzsche with Zarathustra - a procedure which might otherwise seem simplistic - is the extremity of the solitude into which Zarathustra is driven: patently a heroic projection of Nietzsche's own lonely status. It is hard to think of anyone who in the middle of modern Europe succeeded in segregating himself from almost every kind of attachment so completely as Nietzsche did. That at bottom he chose and preferred isolation is, of course, obvious; and that he should have made a heroic virtue of this choice was, given his love of self dramatization, almost inevitable: but that does not mean that he did not suffer as a result of it. So it is that we find, throughout his works, together with celebrations of self sufficiency, reflections on the perils attending it: the chief of these appears to be that the opportunity afforded for self-absorption will lead to an increase in self-knowledge and -awareness so great as to be self-destructive. This is the "abyss" over which Zarathustra "hangs" in his moun tain redoubt. This poem too is, like the preceding poems, autobiography; it is the final stage of a quasi-dramatic development. The last chapter of Human, All Too Human is called "Man Alone with Himself" ; in Zarathustra Nietzsche drew a full-length portrait of a man alone with himself; now, at the end of his course, the man alone with himself discovers that, through his self-imposed solitude, he has become his own executioner. The Fire-Signal (page 47) These twenty-seven measured, solemn and impressive lines employ the vocabulary and setting of Thus Spoke Zarathustra but go one step beyond it. Perhaps we are permitted to recognize in the "six solitudes" which Zarathustra already knows an allusion to his condition at the conclusion of the book named after him: if so, the "seventh solitude" he seeks would represent a new and final stage in his spiritual journey. That this "seventh solitude" is intended to be taken in a fairly literal sense as a [Page 81] description of the years immediately preceding the collect ing together of the Dithyrambs of Dionysus can, I believe, be shown from the persistence in Nietzsche's mind, after the other Zarathustra-metaphors had been left behind, of the metaphor of "fishing for men" which Thus Spoke Zarathustra shares with the New Testament. Like the disciples of Jesus, Zarathustra too was a "fisher of men" who differed from the fishermen of religion chiefly in the kind of bait he used; now, however, he has commenced fishing in a place where even the most enticing bait will catch nothing, namely "on high mountains": thus he explains to himself the absence of any catch except a "seventh solitude". This state of things corresponds pre cisely to the actual state of things in Nietzsche's life at the time

the poem was probably written: though convinced of the tremendous importance to mankind of what he had to tell them, he completely lacked an audience; and he acquired one only after his mental breakdown. "To all that was tragic in Nietzsche's life", George Brandes wrote in 1900 in his obituary of him, "was added this: that, after thirsting for recognition to the point of morbidity, he attained it in an altogether fantastic degree when, though still living, he was shut out from life." Nietzsche himself continued to the end to account for his isolation by employing the fishing metaphor. Writing in *Ecce Homo* of *Beyond Good and Evil*, the book which succeeded *Zarathustra*, he says: "The task for the immediately following years was as clear as it could be. Now that the affirmative part of my task was done, it was the turn of the denying, the No-saying and No-doing part: the revaluation of existing values themselves, the great war- the evocation of a day of decision. Included here is the slow search for those related to me, for such as out of strength would offer me their hand for the work of destruction. - From now on all my writings are fish-hooks: perhaps I understand fishing as well as anyone? . . . If nothing got caught I am not to blame. There were no fish . . . Though the connection is not absolutely direct, I believe [Page 82] this passage to be saying the same thing as a prose restatement of "The Fire-Signal". The Sun Sinks (page 49) The sense of the sixth and by far the calmest of the Dithyrambs of Dionysus is unambiguous to a degree rare in Nietzsche's visionary poems. It is a description of his own death - or, more precisely, of what he anticipates, or at least hopes, his death will be like. What is extremely striking about the poem is the degree to which its imagery is drawn from the stock of simple images and metaphors which Nietzsche has already employed time and again to express feelings of happiness and contentment: their repetition here produces, for anyone who knows Nietzsche's poetic works as a whole, a coda-like effect. Mostly their meaning is so obvious as to make any elucidation superfluous, though it might be worthwhile to draw attention to the number of colours named: gold ("gilt"), green, brown, white, purple, blue, silver. To speak of a "colour symbolism" in Nietzsche's poetry and poetic prose would be to speak too solemnly; but certain colours did have a special significance for him and mention of them is intended to constitute something more than natural description. Gold is, as in the present poem, the colour of the sea when the setting sun is level with it, and it is thus the colour of late evening and of the moods appropriate to that time of day. Brown - which from the number of times he employs it might almost be called Nietzsche's favourite colour - is the colour of wine-grapes when they are perfectly ripe and ready to be harvested, and is thus the colour of sweetness and maturity. *Ariadne's Complaint* (page 53) The seventh of the Dithyrambs of Dionysus has a very strange history. It first appeared, without its title and dramatized ending, in Part Four of *Zarathustra*, in the [Page 83] chapter called "The Sorcerer". As already remarked, the sorcerer is

Richard Wagner, and when Zarathustra first encounters him he is "throwing his arms about as if in a frenzy"; at length he hurls himself to the ground, and when Zarathustra approaches him he is revealed to be "a trembling old man with staring eyes". Failing to realize he is no longer alone, the sorcerer "continually looked around him with pathetic gestures . . . Eventually, however, after much trembling, quivering and self-contortion, he began to wail thus" - and then follows "Who still warms me, who still loves me?" But the song has so ill an effect on Zarathustra that before the sorcerer has finished "he could restrain himself no longer; he took his stick and struck the wailing man with all his force. 'Stop !' he shouted at him with furious laughter, 'Stop, you actor! You fabricator! You liar from the heart! I know you well! . . .'" The grotesque and unpleasing scene continues on for some time, with the sorcerer acquiring increasing enlighten ment as to his . true nature from the all-knowing Zarathustra. It must therefore disconcert us to hear the sorcerer's "lying" lament now proceeding from the semi divine Ariadne and addressed to the wholly divine Dionysus under circumstances which make it impossible to think that the sentiments it expresses are not intended to be taken in earnest. Some explanation is obviously called for, yet there is none that is satisfactory on the "objective", artistic level, and one might be inclined to call this re employment of the poem in a quite different context an artistic blunder. In the last resort, I believe, this judge ment must prevail: the two contexts, both dramatic, in which the poem is employed are artistically irreconcilable with one another, and the poem itself is thus irresolvably ambiguous. On the biographical level, however, the scene in Zarathustra and the scene on N axos are intimately con nected, and it is in this connection that we must seek the cause of the artistic error. In September or October 1887, while staying in Venice, the city Wagner died in, Nietzsche set down the following [Page 84] brief notes for a dramatic sketch: Satyr play at the end Insert: brief conversation between Dionysus, Theseus and Ariadne - Theseus is becoming absurd, said Ariadne, Theseus is be coming virtuous - Theseus jealous of Ariadne's dream. Ariadne's complaint. The hero admiring himself, becoming absurd. Dionysus without jealousy: "That which I love in you, how could a Theseus love that" - - - Last act. Wedding of Dionysus and Ariadne. "One is not jealous when one is a god", said Dionysus, "unless it be of gods." "Ariadne", said Dionysus, "you are a labyrinth: Theseus has gone astray in you, he has lost the thread; of what good is it to him that he is not devoured by the Minotaur? That which devours him is worse than a Minotaur." "You are flattering me", Ariadne replied: "I am weary of my pity, all heroes should perish by me: this is my ultimate love for Theseus: I destroy him." The three characters in this "satyr play" are Nietzsche (Dionysus), Wagner (Theseus) and Wagner's wife and widow, Cosima (Ariadne). If the sketch itself left any doubt as to these attributions it would be set aside by the content of the letters Nietzsche sent out

to people he knew, and to prominent people he did not know, during the days following his mental collapse. Some are signed "Dionysus", and Cosima Wagner is referred to in them as "Ariadne"; one of the letters that went to Cosima herself reads: "Ariadne. I love you. Dionysus". At the clinic at Jena in which he was subsequently confined Nietzsche is recorded as having said: "My wife Cosima Wagner brought me here" - the "wedding of Dionysus and Ariadne" having by then taken place in his now uninhibited fantasy. It thus appears that the poem "Who still warms me, who still loves me?" has simply been taken away from Wagner and given to Cosima, in whose mouth it has acquired a truthfulness it could not possess in Wagner's. [Page 85] Fame and Eternity (page 61) There is some indication that "Fame and Eternity" was at first intended as a poetic epilogue to the autobiography *Ecce Homo*: this intention, if it in fact existed, would have been sensible, since this miniature poetic cycle is itself autobiographical. It records, in the concise way, four stages on Zarathustra's path to enlightenment. Part 1 ("How long have you already brooded") is ferociously depressive: truth, "brimstone-coloured" and sulphurous, a curse and thunderstorm that shakes the rafters, inspires anger in him who says it and fear in those who hear it. A prose equivalent is provided in *Ecce Homo* in the characterization of *On the Genealogy of Morals*: The three essays of which this Genealogy consists are in regard to expression, intention and art of surprise perhaps the uncanniest things that have ever been written. Dionysus is, as one knows, also the god of darkness. - Each time a beginning which is intended to mislead, cool, scientific, even ironic, intentionally foreground, intentionally keeping in suspense. Gradually an increasing disquiet; isolated flashes of lightning; very unpleasant truths becoming audible as a dull rumbling in the distance - until at last a tempo ferociously attained in which every thing surges forward with tremendous tension. At the conclusion each time amid perfectly awful detonations a new truth visible between thick clouds. Part 2 ("This coin") appears to repudiate "fame", actually repudiates the purchase of fame by the substitution of virtue for truth - the trimming of truth to the world's moral demands. The third and fourth poems transport us to the end of Part Three of Zarathustra, the ecstatic conclusion of Zarathustra's spiritual odyssey and his attainment of full enlightenment. The euphoric imagery is here so closely compacted as sometimes to constitute almost a series of catchwords and -phrases whose meaning, though well and unequivocally established in Nietzsche's earlier writings and familiar to readers of them, is by no means conveyed by the text of the poem itself. I think I shall have [Page 86] done my duty by the reader if I offer, not a full "explication" of this text - which would in any case probably exhaust his/her patience - but the following key which may by itself prove adequate to unlocking it. The passage again comes from *Ecce Homo*: My formula for greatness in a human being is amor fati: that one wants nothing to be

other than it is, not in the future, not in the past, not in all eternity. Not merely to endure that which happens of necessity, still less to dissemble it - all idealism· is untruthfulness in the face of necessity - but to love it Of the Poverty of the Richest Man (page 69) The last of the Dithyrambs of Dionysus relaxes tempo and tension. It is the happiest poem in the collection. The opening line answers the question asked by the opening lines of "Fame and Eternity" and in doing so recalls the opening of Thus Spoke Zarathustra: When Zarathustra was thirty years old, he left his home and the lake of his home and went into the mountains. Here he had the enjoyment of his spirit and his solitude and he did not weary of it for ten years. But at last his heart turned - and one morning he rose with the dawn, stepped before the sun, and spoke to it thus . . . In the light of these correspondences, it is probably not far-fetched to conclude that the "Zarathustras" of the Dithyrambs of Dionysus are not so much repetitions of the grand central figure of Thus Spoke Zarathustra as alternatives to him.

The following sections contain Nietzsche's unpublished notebook fragments, presented in chronological order as they appear in the Stanford Complete Works critical edition. These are not finished works but working notes, drafts, and abandoned projects — they show Nietzsche thinking on the page. The reader should treat them as a workshop, not a gallery.

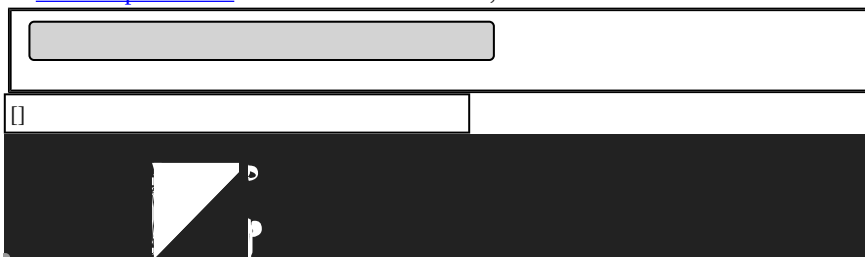
Appendix A

Nachlass Volume 14: Unpublished Fragments from the Period of Thus Spoke Zarathustra (Summer 1882 – Winter 1883/84)

Translated by Paul S. Loeb & David F. Tinsley

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/84)
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Loeb and David F. Tinsley
teen
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ized in English by Ernst Behler

Video

Fragments
Period of Thus Spoke Zarathustra
2-Winter 1883/84)
ietzsche

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Period of Thus Spoke Zarathustra
2– Winter 1883 / 84)
with an Afterword,
Loeb and David F. Tinsley
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A Note on This Edition

This is the first English translation of all of Nietzsche's writings,

including his unpublished fragments, with annotation, afterwords concerning the individual texts, and indexes, in nineteen volumes. The aim of this collaborative work is to produce a critical edition for scholarly use. Volume 1 also includes

an introduction to the entire edition, and Volume 19 will include

a detailed chronology of Nietzsche's life. While the goal is to

establish a readable text in contemporary English, the translation follows the original as closely as possible. All texts have

been translated anew by a group of scholars, and particular attention has been given to maintaining a consistent terminology throughout the volumes. The translation is based on

Friedrich Nietzsche: Sämtliche Werke. Kritische Studienausgabe in 15

Bänden (1980), edited by Giorgio Colli and Mazzino Montinari.

The still-progressing Nietzsche Werke: Kritische Gesamtausgabe,

which Colli and Montinari began in 1963, has also been consulted. The Colli-Montinari edition is of particular importance

for the unpublished fragments, comprising more than half of Nietzsche's writings and published there for the first time

in their entirety. Besides listing textual variants, the annotation to

this English edition provides succinct information on the

text

and identifies events, names (except those in the Index of Persons), titles, quotes, and biographical facts of Nietzsche's own life. The notes are numbered in the text and are keyed by phrase.

The Afterword presents the main facts about the origin of the

x A NOTE ON THIS EDITION

text, the stages of its composition, and the main events of its

reception. The Index of Persons includes mythological figures

and lists the dates of birth and death as well as prominent personal characteristics.

Since the first three volumes appeared,

important corrections to the 1980 edition of the Kritische Studien-

ausgabe have been noted, and these corrections have been incorporated

into the translation that appears here.

ERNST BEHLER AND ALAN D. SCHRIFT

Unpublished Fragments

from the Period of Thus Spoke Zarathustra

(Summer 1882–Winter 1883/84)

Preliminary Note to Volume 14

Volumes 14 and 15 of the Complete Works of Friedrich Nietzsche (Volumes 10 and 11 of the KSA) together comprise Nietzsche's unpublished fragments from July 1882 to Autumn 1885, which correspond to Part VII of the KGW. The fragments are preserved in thirty-six manuscripts, specifically in twenty-one

notebooks in larger format, twelve notebooks, and three loose-

leaf binders.

The organizing principles that govern the publication of Nietzsche's unpublished fragments are set forth in the Preliminary

Note to CW 10.

In addition, the following comments concerning Volumes 14 and 15 of CW should be noted. The manuscripts from the period July 1882 to Autumn 1885 include preliminary work on the four parts of Thus Spoke Zarathustra; drafts, outlines, and

fragments that have to do with parts of this work that were not included; extensive collections of sayings that in many cases relate to work on Z; and notes that – in literary terms

– have no relation to Z (the latter make up approximately half of the complete material; they were published as a small

part of the notebooks related to Beyond Good and Evil [and included in CW 16]). All of these notes are being published as

Z-fragment literary remains, which precede the actual early drafts and final clean copies of each part of Z. Yet since Nietzsche,

each time after completing a part of Z, recopied a large

number of the previous notes that he hadn't used into new
2 PRELIMINARY NOTE TO VOLUME 14

notebooks, often without changing anything, it was impossible to avoid the repetition of certain notes – although in differing contexts.

Volume 14 of CW corresponds to Volume VII/1 of the KGW (Berlin / New York: Walter de Gruyter, 1977) and thus contains the fragments from July 1882 to Winter 1883-84. Nietzsche's Tautenburg Notes for Lou von Salomé (July–August 1882) are published with the kind permission of Dr. (Honorary) Ernst Pfeiffer (Göttingen).

There is no Afterword by Giorgio Colli for Volume 14.

MAZZINO MONTINARI

Editorial Note to Volume 14

Unless another volume in the CW is cited, all cross-references

to fragments in the notes are references to fragments in this

volume. In cases where a cross-reference to a fragment is followed

by a number (e.g., 5[1] 22), this indicates that the reference

is to the sentence or paragraph numbered 22 in fragment si]. In cases where a cross-reference to a fragment is followed

by an underline and a number (e.g., 22[1]547), this indicates

that the reference is to a passage in fragment 22[1] that appears

on page 547 of this volume.

In cases where the format of a fragment in this volume differs significantly from the format of the fragment as it appears

in KSA, we have chosen to follow as closely as possible the format of the fragment as it appears in Nietzsche's handwritten

notebooks.

ALAN D. SCHRIFT

[1 =N V 9a. N VI 1a. Tautenburg Notes
for Lou von Salomé. July-August 1882]

1 [1]

"solitudo continuata dulcescit" Madonna del Sasso. (Locarno)?

1 [2]

Refutation of Morality? –

Morality is what matters to those who cannot free themselves from it: it is for that very reason one of the "conditions

of existence" for them. It is impossible to refute conditions of

existence: We can only – not have them?

1 [3] Basic Principles

The final physical state of force we unlock must necessarily also be the first.

The dissolution of force into latent force must be the cause of the emergence of the most vigorous force. The state of the

highest position must follow the one state of negation.

Space, like matter, is a subjective form. Time is not.

Space first emerged through the assumption of empty space.

This doesn't exist. Force is everything.

We are incapable of conceiving simultaneously what is moved and what is moving, but that is what makes matter and space. We isolate.

The development of a thing allows retrospective conclusions about its emergence.

4 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

All development is an emergence.

Matter, material is a subjective form.

We cannot conceive of anything except as being material.

Even thoughts and abstractions obtain from us a very refined materiality, which we perhaps deny: nevertheless they do have

it. We have accustomed ourselves to overlook this sophisticated materiality and to speak of "the immaterial." Just as we

have distinguished dead from alive, logical from illogical, etc.

To unlearn' our oppositions – is the task.

1 [4]

Even concepts have emerged. From where? – There are transitions here.

x [5]°

People who were employed for an enterprise which has failed should be doubly compensated.

1 [6]'

If you want to stay young for a long time, become young late.

"Anyone who is too strict in his judgment of others is bad in

my opinion" – I say with Demosthenes.

1 [7]

"Suaviter in re, fortiter in me"?

1 [8]?

What all the resurrected believe. – It is highly unlikely that

someone who has died early once will die a second time.

I [9]!°

Life after death. – Those who have reason to believe in their "life after death" must learn to endure their "death" during their life.

1 JULY-AUGUST 1882 5

1 fo]!

Late youth. – Late youth sustains long youth.

1 [mn]?

The ideal. – The eye sees everything as outside itself: and thus we still see our ideal before us, even if we have already reached it!

1 [12]

Concept and feeling of "noble" has a different prehistory than concept and feeling of "good."

1 [13]"? Vademecum. Vadetecum!? By F. Nietzsche First Complete Edition

Contents:

Human, All Too Human. With Appendix The Wanderer and His Shadow Dawn The Joyful Science.

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Contents:

Human, All Too Human. With Appendix:

Mixed Opinions and Maxims. The Wanderer and His Shadow.

Dawn. Thoughts on the Presumptions of Morality.
The Joyful Science.

6 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

1 [15]? To---

Friend!!° – spoke Columbus – do not trust
a Genoese ever again!
He's always staring into the blue,
What is most distant draws him all too much!

*

Courage! I am on the open sea,
Behind me lies Genoa.
And in league with you I will win
Lands of gold and America.

*

Let us stand on our own two feet!
For us there is no more turning back.
Look outward: greeting us from far away
One death, one fame, one fortune!718

I [16]

a largely or exclusively vegetarian diet
People of strong affects, ambitious invidious lascivious
peo-
ple may in fact wish to ask themselves whether for them a
little
meat is already too much, although for me the much more
important question than what they should eat, is that other
question: how much, which here means: how little.

1 [17]

As when a friend tears himself away from a friend's bosom.
Go ahead! You will still have your pain!!?

1 [18]

What is my book worth if it cannot at least endure the scrutiny
sub specie trecentorum annorum???

1] JULY-AUGUST 1882 7

1 [19]? Free spirits. Style. Moral and organic. Selfishness
and neighborliness.?? Heroism.

The effect of the thought on the future of the world.
God and devil.

1 [20]

On the Morality of the "I."

The difficulty of making oneself understood. This is impos-
si-

ble to do with many people.

Every action is misunderstood. And in order not to have
continual encounters, it is necessary to have a mask. Also
in

order to seduce...

Better to associate with people who consciously lie, for only they can also be consciously truthful. Usually, truthfulness is

a mask that is not conscious of being a mask.

The "I" subjugates and kills: it works like an organic cell: it

pillages and is violent. It wants to regenerate itself – pregnancy.

It wants to give birth to its god and to see all of humanity at its feet."

°

The I's that have been liberated fight for mastery.

1 [21]

This is no book: what use are books!

What use are coffins and shrouds!

This is a will, this is a promise,

This is a last burning-of-bridges,

This is a sea breeze, a weighing of the anchor,

A roaring of the paddlewheels, a setting of the tiller,

The cannon roars, its fire a white steam

The sea laughs, the monster –*4

8 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

1 [22]

to give selfishness a beautiful name, after it is supposed to

be evil

1 [23]

I believe G. I. Ascoli and E. Rénan when they say that the Semitic race was Indoeuropean.

x [24]?°

The lives of heroic humans contain the abbreviated history of multiple generations in regard to the deification of the devil. They experience in turn what it is to be heretic, witch, prophet, skeptic, weakling, believer and what it is to be overwhelmed.

1 [25]""

Those who themselves possess the will to suffer are differently disposed to cruelty; when they inflict hurt, they do not

believe hurting to be in and of itself damaging and bad.

1 [26]

"Jesus saw someone working on the Sabbath and said to him: if you know what you do, then you are blessed; but if

you

know not what you do, then you are cursed and a violator of the law."

Luke, 6,4. ancient ms.

1 [27]

The existing world of forces leads back to a most simple state

of these forces: and in the same way forward to a most simple

state, – could and must both these states not be identical?

No

infinite number of states can be derived from one system of specific forces, that is, from one measurably stable force.

Only

with the false assumption of an infinite space into which force

dissipates, as it were, is the final state an unproductive, dead

state. The simplest state is at once – and +

1 JULY-AUGUST 1882 9

1 [28]

If we adopt the strictest standpoint of morality, e.g., sincerity-

ity, then any interaction with things, all of the articles of faith

within our usual sphere of action, are already immoral (e.g.,

that there are bodies.

Likewise, suppose that human = human in place of the atomism of individuals.

In this way everything becomes dishonesty. And assuming we acknowledge that life is dishonesty, thus immorality – in this way life can be denied.

In the same way, unconditional justice brings the insight that life is essentially unfair.

Consequence of the most extreme morality of knowledge: demand for annihilation.

But now the critique of morals and morality makes its redemptive arrival: it does away with itself.

Therefore: life is not to be denied, for morality does not stand above it, morality is dead. The excess of morality has shown that its antithesis, evil, is necessary and useful, and is a

source of what is good.

Having done that, should we give up what is good? No, absolutely not! For our honesty no longer needs to be so

strict.

Good people certainly are not.

1 [29]?

Emotional needs should not be confused with the need for emotions: that a few extremely cold people possess.

1 [30]

Dogs respond to benevolence with submission. Cats enjoy themselves in its presence and have a lascivious feeling of power: they give nothing back.

x [31]?

In explanation of the so-called "spiritistic phenomena." A portion of the intellectual functions of the medium?! occurs
10 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

in him unconsciously: his condition is thereby hypnotic (sepa-

ration of a waking and sleeping intellect) The nervous energy

is concentrated in this unconscious portion. – An electric current must then pass among the people holding hands in the direction of the medium, allowing each person's thoughts to pass over into the medium. A current of thoughts like this

is no more marvelous than the message carried from the brain to the foot within a person when he stumbles. The questions are answered through the intellectual capacity of the participants:

whereby memory often contributes and offers something that usually seems to have been forgotten. Result of nervous emotion. – There is no forgetting. – Even unconscious deception is possible: I mean, a deceptive medium operates

with any number of deceptive manipulations, without knowing it: his kind of morality finds instinctive expression in

these actions. – Ultimately, this is always the case, with all of

our actions. The most essential things occur unconsciously in

us, and ninety times out of hundred and even more often the con artist is more unaware of himself as a con artist than aware.

Electrical phenomena, cold chills, sparks are all possible in

such cases. Feelings of being touched may be the products of trickery, hallucinations of the senses: whereby it is possible

that several people share the same hallucina(tion). (Such as with the ancient orgiastic cults)

The belief in being reunited with the dead is the presupposition of spiritism. It is a kind of freethinking. Truly pious

people do not need this belief. (Buckle*? on immortality)

1 [32]

Advocatus diaboli"?

New representations of God and devil. Unconditional knowledge is a form of madness from the era of virtue; with it,

life would perish. We must sanctify lies, delusions and faith,

injustice. We must liberate ourselves from morality, to be able

to live morally. My free choice,' the ideal I myself created

1 JULY-AUGUST 1882 II

demands this or that virtue from me, i.e., downfall as a result of

virtue. This is heroism.

1 [33]

The principle of nations will free the Mohammedans the Indians from their bonds.

1 [34]

So what makes, e.g., prostitution, so destructive, sneaky, unsure of itself? Not "the evil in itself" within it, but rather

the bad opinion in which it is held. This against statisticians.

In the case of good people what should be taken into account is that the more direct and more subtle aftereffect of their judgment-

ments is what constitutes the inner and outer misery of human-

ity. And then they use this misery as evidence that they are right, as evidence of nature and force! Bad conscience poisons

good health.

Marriage as the sanctioned form of satisfying lust.

War as the sanctioned form of murdering your neighbor.

School as the sanctioned form of training.

Justice as the sanctioned form of revenge.

Religion as the sanctioned form of the drive for knowledge.

Good people as Pharisees, evil people living with bad consciences and oppression. So what is debauchery of any kind other than the consequence of the dissatisfaction of so many

with sanctioned forms? What is most criminality other than the inability or unwillingness to participate in the Aypocrisy of "good people"? Lack of training of the strong drives? There are only opponents and despisers of such thinking.

I UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

1 [35]

On the happiness of the Pharisees.
Their self-overcoming. Producing "ethical" actions in all circumstances and training themselves to keep only such motives in their awareness and to falsely label their real motives (namely as ethical).

This is the ancient practice within the herd: the actual dishonesty, to see in themselves only the sanctioned judgments and feelings. This practice, common to all good people, gives rise to the uniformity of common actions: it gives them their monstrous power to acknowledge so few motives in themselves and their neighbors, and only good ones.
The Pharisee is the prototype of the preserving human, always needed.

Antithesis:

the strong evil ones
and the weak evil ones, who feel this way.
From them there occasionally emerges the one-who-is-good-to-himself, the devil who has become God.

[36]

To minimize suffering and to remove oneself from suffering (i.e., from life) – this is supposed to be moral?
To create suffering – for oneself and for others – to make them fit for the highest form of life, that of the victor – would be my goal.

1 [(37)]

It is nauseating to see great humans venerated by Pharisees. Against this sentimentality.

[38]

Even reversal and decline, in the individual and in humanity, must engender their ideals: and the belief in progress will

always endure. The "ape" ideal could at some time stand before humanity – as a goal.

1] JULY-AUGUST 1882 13

1 [39]

My virtuosity: to endure what is unpleasant to me, to do justice to it, yes even to oppose it playfully – humans and knowledge. In this I am the most practiced.

1 [40]°

I have a tendency to allow myself to be robbed, exploited. But as soon as I realized that everything was meant to deceive

me, I moved into egoism.

[41]

Having emerged from the old, perfected morality I felt compelled toward selfishness.

1 [42]

Why do I love free-spiritedness? As the final consequence of morality up to now. Treat everything justly, rise above com-

pulsion and repulsion, become a part of the order of things, be

above oneself, overcoming and courage not only in regard to one's personal enemies, embarrassments, but also in regard to

the evil in things, to honesty even as an opponent of idealism

and piety, yes even of passion, even in regard to honesty itself;

loving attitude toward anything and everything and the good will to discover its value, its justification, its necessity. To refuse

to act (quietism) out of the inability to say: "it should be other-

wise" – to rest in God, as it were, in a God who is becoming.

I recognized selfishness as a means to this free-spiritedness, as

necessary in order not to be devoured by things: as restraint

and refuge. That completion of morality is only possible in an

I: insofar as it acts in a lively, constructive, demanding, creative

manner, and in every moment resists being absorbed in things, it reserves its power for itself in order to force ever more

things to be taken up and absorbed into itself. In relation to the self and to selfishness, free-spiritedness is therefore a becoming, a struggle between two opposites, with nothing resolved, nothing perfected, no state:"" it is the insight of morality,

14

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

which can preserve itself in its existence and in its development

only by means of its opposite.

1 [43] I.

o ~N

Dissatisfaction with ourselves. Antidote for remorse.

The transformation of the temperaments (e.g., through inorganic entities). The good will toward this dissatisfaction. To let the good will's thirst grow and reach its peak in order to discover its wellspring."®

. To reshape death? as the means to victory and triumph.

. Sexual love, as the means to the ideal (longing to be submerged in its opposite.) Love for the suffering godhead.

. Illness, and response to it, freedom until death.

. Reproduction as the most holy of circumstances.

Pregnancy, the creation of the woman and the man, who want to enjoy their oneness in the child and to create a monument to this oneness?

. Compassion as danger. To create conditions, so that all could help themselves and so that it is up to them whether they should be helped.

. The education into evil, into one's own "devil."

. The inner war, as "development."

9. "Preservation of the species" and the thought of eternal IO.

1 [44]

recurrence.

To what degree every created god in turn creates a devil for himself. And this devil is not the god from whom he emerged. (This devil is the neighboring ideal, with which this god must struggle)

The state has forced the individual to incorporate its morality.

Choice*! perhaps once the most exalted name for morality

1 JULY-AUGUST 1882 I

1 [45]* Style

The first thing needed is /zfe: style should /ive.

Your style should fit you every time in regard to one person in particular, to whom you wish to communicate yourself.

We must first know precisely: "I would say and state this in such a way" – before we may begin writing. Writing should only be a kind of imitation.

xk

Because writers Jack many tools enjoyed by speakers, they must in general have as their model a very expressive kind of

speech: the written reproduction of it will necessarily come across much less colorfully (and much more naturally to you).

Wealth in life reveals itself through wealth of gesture. We must learn to feel everything, length brevity of sentences, punctuation, choice of words, pauses, the order of arguments – as gestures.

*

Careful with periods! Only those people with real stamina, also in speaking, have the right to use periods. For most people the period is an affectation.

Style should demonstrate that we believe in our thoughts,

that we not only think them, but also feel them.

OK

The more abstract the truth we want to teach, the more we have to seduce the senses into embracing it.

The tact of good prose writers consists in approaching the boundaries of poesy as closely as possible without ever crossing the line. It is impossible to have this tact without the finest

feeling for and abilities in poetry itself.

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It is not good form, nor is it smart, to anticipate the more obvious objections of our readers. It is very good form and smart, to leave the expression of our essential wisdom to the

readers themselves.

1 [46]

G. Sand, Letter of 1868 to Maxime Du Camp.

"Faites un mariage d'amitié pour avoir des enfants. L'amour ne

procrée guère. Quand vous verrez devant vous un être, que vous

aimerez plus que vous-mêmes, vous serez heureux. Mais ce
nest
pas la femme que l'on peut aimer plus que soi-même, c'est
l'en-
fant, c'est V'être innocent, c'est le type divin, qui dis-
paraît plus ou
moins en grandissant, mais qui, durant quelques années, nous
ramène à la possession d'un idéal sur la terre."

1 [47]

Behind all the feelings a man has for a woman there still
lies

contempt for the female sex.

1 [48] Against moral outrage.

The same cruelty as in religious wars. "Contempt for fellow
humans" as the object of Christ's indignation (he came to
treat the Pharisees unjustly.)

(Evil must be preserved!)

4 1 [49]°

Anyone who has the ideal of a person perceives the real per-
son as its caricature.

1 [so]

1. Female assessment of the affects.

– of the individual virtues and vices of men and
women. women and work

1 JULY-AUGUST 1882 17

women and state women and fame.

2. Female judgment and women's faith in the accuracy of
their judgment.

4. To proclaim as true the unreality to which women feel
themselves obligated.

5. Seducing others into having a high opinion of us, and
then bowing before this opinion as an authority.*°

7. Pregnancy as the quintessential condition, which has
gradually shaped the essence of women. Relation of all modes
of female thought and action to this.

8. Child raising partly educationally regressive – partly
all too deinfantilizing. Female rationalism.

9. The difference between female and male
imperiousness.*"

u. What is felt to be unwomanly. History.

12. Denying destroying hating taking revenge: why
women are more barbaric in these things than men.48

1 [s]

On the Reemergence" of the World.

A position emerges from two negations, if the negations are
forces. (Darkness emerges from light against light, cold

from
warmth against warmth etc.)

x [52]!

Throw your words out ahead of your deeds: obligate yourself through shame at the broken word.

1 [53]

Only people who are unrelenting may be silent concerning themselves.

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1 [54]

We are fairer to others than to ourselves.

1 [55]

In regard to all truth, things work the same way for us as they do in regard to our inner organs.

1 [56]

Originally a lie was moral. The opinions of the herd were simulated.

3 1 [57]?

In order to have a good conversation, some seek a midwife for their thoughts, while others seek someone they can help.

4 1 [58]

In every three-way conversation one voice is superfluous and thereby keeps the conversation from getting deep.

1 [59]

Those who do not make us productive will surely leave us indifferent. Those we make productive still do not give us a reason for loving them.

1 [60]°°

How good people imagine great humans. Against their sentimentality.

1 [61]

To formulate ideals, i.e., to re-create our devil as our god.

And to do that, we must have created our devil in the first place.

1 [62]°°

Everything good came out of something evil.

1 JULY-AUGUST 1882 19

x [63]?

People who strive for greatness find quantitative reasons for

their perfection and satisfaction. People of quality strive for

something puny.

1 [64]

The state of becoming absolutely cold to all previously held

values precedes the state of warming up to them.

1 [65]°°

I am the advocatus diaboli® and God's accuser.

1 [66]?

The human being is too imperfect a thing. Love for a human being would destroy me.

1 [67]

Cruelty in enjoying compassion. Compassion is strongest, the deeper we come to know and love the other. Consequently those lovers who are cruel to the ones they love will get the

most enjoyment from cruelty. Assuming we love ourselves the most, then the highest enjoyment found in compassion would be cruelty to ourselves. Heroic = this is striving for an absolute

downfall into one's opposite, the reshaping of the devil into

God:® this is that degree of cruelty.

1 [68]

The conditions of existence of a being, as soon as they represent

themselves as an "ought," are its morality.

1 [69]°% How the devil becomes God.

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1 [70]° On the Philosophy of Recurrence

on heroic greatness as the only state of those who are preparing the way.

(Striving for absolute downfall as means of enduring ourselves.)

Wanting to become a function: feminine ideal of love. The masculine ideal is assimilation and overwhelming domination or compassion (veneration of the suffering God).

absolute indifference to the opinions of others (because we know them through and through'°): but compassionate in our opinion of ourselves.

We must not want a single state, but must rather want to become repeating beings" = similar to existence.

I deliberately chose to live out my days in complete opposition to the life of someone with a religious nature. I know the

devil and his plans for God.°®

"Good" and "evil" as sensations of pleasure and displeasure. Indispensable. But for each is evil.

Those who do not find the way to their ideal live more frivolously

and more brazenly than those who have no ideal at

all.

To hurt those we love – is the real devilry. In regard to our-selves it is the state of the heroic human being – the highest

abuse of power. To strive for the opposite is part of this.

1 [71]

“Idealist” as the opposite of the honest and fearless one who

knows. The judgments of idealists disgust me, they are completely useless.

1 JULY-AUGUST 1882 2I

1 bee

Joy in others being hurt is something other than cruelty, the

latter is delight in compassion, and reaches its height whenever

compassion is at its highest (at the point that we love the one

we are tormenting).

If another were to hurt the ones we love, then we would become insane with rage, compassion in that case would be wholly painful. But we love them: and we hurt them. In that way compassion acquires a monstrous allure: it is the contradiction of two strongly opposed drives, which functions here as the highest allure.

Juxtaposed, self-mutilation and sensuality are the same. Or the clearest consciousness and torpor and lethargy after opium.

1 [73]

General question: how do contradictory feelings function, in other words, a duality? How do they relate as duality? (Weakening?)

The highest love for the I, when it expresses itself as heroism,

is accompanied by lust for self-destruction, that is, cruelty,

self-violation.’!

Those who loved humanity have hurt it the most”?

The beloved’s unconditional surrender and delight in suffering, the desire to be mistreated. Surrender becomes defiance against one’s self.

On the other hand, the man who is loved, who torments what loves him, enjoys his feeling of power, and even more so,

the more he tyrannizes himself in the process: it is a doubled exercise of power. Here will for power'? becomes defiance against one's self.⁷⁴

1 [74]

The freethinker as the most religious person that now exists.

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1 [75]? God killed God.

1[761° Morals died from morality.

1 [7717

A person of faith"? is the opposite of a religious person.

1 [78]?

Precondition of procreation should be the will to want to have an image and a legacy of the beloved person: and a monument to oneness with that person, indeed a consummation of the drive for oneness, through a new being. – A matter of passion and not of sympathy.

1 [79]

The preeminent and honest form of sexual relations, that of passion, is now accompanied by evil conscience. And the basest

and the most dishonest by good conscience.

1 [80]

The confusion of the means used to preserve marriage: the woman believes that she is predestined only for this one marriage.

In truth everything is mere chance, and a hundred other

men would be just as good for her. She wants to obey: she works for the man and thinks and says: "what haven't I done for you!" – but this was not done for "you," but rather for someone or other, who came within range of her drives. – The spouses are separated by career and daily work, which keeps things bearable. – Because men and women?! have not experienced earlier what friendship really is, they are not disappointed by the interaction: they know neither love nor

friendship. Marriage is designed for atrophied half-humans.

1 JULY-AUGUST 1882 23

1 [81] Vain – insulted cautious – take heed immoral – des-

pise.

1 [82]

He kills when he cannot live otherwise.

He robs when he needs an object or a person (marriage).
He lies when he wants to remain concealed for the sake of his goal.

x [83] Noon and Eternity Outline of a heroic philosophy.

1 [84]°°

Humans who strive for greatness are usually evil humans: it is the only way they can live with themselves.

1 [85]*4

How long (how many centuries) it takes before greatness becomes visible to humanity as greatness and shines – is my measure of greatness. It has probably been the case up until now that all the greatest ones are exactly the ones who have remained concealed.

1 [86]%

Anyone who no longer finds greatness in God no longer finds greatness anywhere and must deny its existence or – create it –

help to create it.

8 x [87]°°

The enormous expectations that women?" bring to sexual love blind their eye to all broader perspectives.

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1 [88]8

Heroism – this is the mentality of human beings who believe that they count for nothing in comparison to their goals.

Heroism is the good will toward absolute self-destruction.®?

The opposite of the heroic ideal is the ideal of harmonic total development: a beautiful opposite and one very much worth wishing for! But an ideal only for good human beings!

1 [89]

All h(uman) interaction revolves solely around pregnancy.

r [90°

When five people speak together, a sixth always has to die.

x [1]?!

All girls believe that a man makes friends with a woman only because he couldn't get any further with her.

1 [92]

Anyone who does not see what is superior in p(eople) will focus too much on what is base and with all too sharp an eye.

1 [93]?

When talents fade, a p(erson's) moral qualities become more visible.

1 [94]

Men are considered cruel, but women are cruel. Women are

considered kind-hearted, but men are kind-hearted.

1 [95]

Ah, I'm so fed up with tragic faces and phrases!

1 [96] Schilling, Span(ish) Grammar, Leipzig, Glockner.>*

1 JULY-AUGUST 1882 25

1 [97]" Should a bond not tear,
you must try biting into it.'

1 [98]

Occasionally I feel enormous disdain for good people –
their weakness, their wanting to experience nothing, their
wanting to see nothing, their capricious blindness, their
banal

wallowing in what is routine and comfortable, their pleasure
in their own "good qualities" etc.

1 [99]"

Hitzig Untersuchungen über das Gehirn Berlin 1874.°8

Animal Depravity (Quarterly Journal of Science"? 1875

415-430. Lilienfeld Gedanken über die Socialwissenschaft.'""

1 [100]

Cosa bella e mortal,
passa e non dural!!!

1 [ror]!

Columbus novus.

That's the way I want to go, and I trust

Myself from now on and my grip!

Open is the sea: into the blue

Sails my Genoese ship.

xx

Everything becomes new and newer to me

Behind me lies Genoa.

Courage! You yourself stand at the helm,

Dearest Victorial!0%1%

(Summer 1882)

26 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

1 [r]!06

The tree speaks.

Too alone I grew and too high:

I wait: but what am I waiting for, anyway?

xx

Too near to me is the throne of clouds:

I wait for the first lightning bolt.!"

1 [103] To the Ideal.

Whom have I loved as I love you, beloved shadow!

I pulled you to me, into me – and ever since

I have almost become a shadow, you a body.

It's only that my eye is unteachable,

Accustomed to seeing things outside itself:
 For it, you will always be the eternal "Outside-of myself"
 Alas, this eye is making me feel beside myself!°8!
 1 [ro]! "Joyful Science." (Sanctus Januarius)!!!
 This is no book: what use are books!
 These shrouds and coffins!
 The past is the prey of books:
 Yet in them lives an eternal today.!!*
 1 [105] In the Mountains. (1876.)
 No way back? And no way forward?
 Not even a path for mountain goats?
 xx
 So I wait here and hold on"! tightly,
 To whatever hand and eye will let me hold!!!
 7K
 1 JULY-AUGUST 1882
 Earth five feet wide, dawn,
 And below me – world, humans and – death!!!
 1 [106] To Friendship. Hail to you, friendship! My highest
 hope's First dawn!
 Alas, trail and night often Seemed endless to me,
 All life
 Aimless and despised!
 I want to live twice,
 Now I gaze into your eyes'
 Morning splendor and triumph, You most beloved goddess!!!"
 1 [107]
 The Phrase.' '®
 I'm a friend of the lively phrase:
 That jumps out at us with such good faith,
 That greets us with an artful curtsy,
 Endearing even in its clumsiness,
 Has blood within, can sniff heartily,
 Creeps even into deaf ears,
 And circles and flutters even now,
 And what it does – the phrase delights.
 Yet the phrase remains a delicate creature,
 Quickly ill but just as quickly healed.
 If you wish to let it live its fleeting life,
 Then your grip must be refined and light,
 Don' crudely grab and crush it,
 It often dies under an evil eye –
 And then lies there, so shapeless,
 So soulless, so poor and cold,
 Its tiny corpse terribly transformed,
 28 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Mutilated by death and dying.
 A dead phrase – an ugly thing,
 A bone-on-bone cling, cling, cling. Shame on every ugly
 business,
 Through which phrases and words die!
 119,120
 [Tautenburg Notes for Lou von Salomé)!"

1 [r]!?? Ls
 Humans who strive for greatness are usually evil humans; it
 is the only way they can live with themselves.

2.
 Anyone who no longer finds greatness in God, no longer
 finds greatness anywhere and must either deny its existence
 or
 – create it (help create it)

(3.)
 [+++]

4.
 The enormous expectations that women! bring to sexual
 love blind their eye to all long-range perspectives.
 Heroism – this is the mentality of human beings who believe
 that they count for nothing in comparison to their goals.
 Heroism
 is the good will toward absolute self-destruction.

6.
 The opposite of the heroic ideal is the ideal of harmonic
 total
 development – a beautiful opposite and one very much worth
 wishing for! But an ideal only for basically good human be-
 ings
 (e.g., Goethe)

1 JULY-AUGUST 1882 29
 Love is completely different for men than for women.!?* For
 most men, love is a kind of avarice; for the rest, love is
 the
 veneration of a suffering and shrouded deity."
 If friend Rée ever read this, he would think I'm crazy.
 How is it going? – There has never been a more beautiful
 day in Tautenburg than today. The air clear, mild, bracing:
 just as we all should be.
 Cordially
 F.N.
 I [109]!2°
 On a Theory of Style
 L
 The first thing needed is life: style should /ive.

2.

Your style should fit you in regard to one person in particular, to whom you wish to communicate yourself. (Law of double relation.)

We must first know precisely: "I would say and state this in such a way" – before we may begin writing. Writing must be a kind of imitation.

Because the writers Jack many tools enjoyed by speakers, they must in general have as their model a very expressive kind

of speech: the written reproduction of it will necessarily come

across much less colorfully.

5.

Wealth in life reveals itself through wealth of gesture. We must learn to feel everything, length and brevity of sentences,

30 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

punctuation, choice of words, pauses, the order of arguments – as gestures.

6.

Careful with periods! Only those people with real stamina, also in speaking, have the right to use periods. For most people

the period is an affectation.

7.

Style should demonstrate that we believe in our thoughts, that we not only think them, but also feel them.

8.

The more abstract the truth we want to teach, the more we must first seduce our senses into embracing it.

9.

The tact of good prose writers in selecting their methods consists in approaching the boundaries of poetic style as closely

as possible without ever crossing the line.

10.

It is not good form, nor is it smart to anticipate the more obvious objections of our readers. It is very good form and very smart to leave the expression of our essential wisdom to the

readers themselves.

F.N.

A good morning to you, my dear Lou!

1 JULY-AUGUST 1882 31

[110]!77

"Yes, a weaker sex!" – this is the way men talk about women,!7® this is also the way women!77 talk about themselves: but who believes that they are thinking the same thing

when they use the same words? But let the men think whatever they like for now; what does a woman usually mean when she speaks of the weakness of her sex? –

To feel weakness – this means not only to feel a lack of power, but rather: to feel a need for power.!7© She looks for

power, she looks outside of herself for it, she wants support,

she is a cornucopia of everything that she could possibly lean

on, she coils herself demandingly around things that are not capable of giving support and attempts to hold on to them, yes

she likes to delude herself about the power of everything different from or foreign to her – she believes just as

strongly in the power outside herself as she does in the weakness within herself. The feeling of weakness, felt at its most extreme, finds

strength everywhere and projects power into everything outside of itself with which it comes into contact: and whenever

the eye should contradict this, then the eye is – shut!

Such in fact is the state in which the weaker sex finds itself,

and not just in relation to the men of its acquaintance, but also in regard to religion and custom: the weak woman believes in her inability to stand without support and turns ev-

everything that surrounds her physically and spiritually into props – she does not want to see what all this really is, she

does not want to test whether the balustrade along which she crosses the river will really hold up, she believes in the balus-

trade, because she believes in her own weakness and fear.

Whatever a woman in her situation leans on is in all cases not

the power she knows, but rather the power she expects, wishes

for and projects: and the greater her feeling of weakness,
the
more power she will want to feel in whatever "gives her support."
The weakest woman will make a god out of every man:
and similarly something holy, inviolable, final, worshipful
out
of every precept of custom and religion. It is obvious that
the
32

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

weaker sex is more important for the emergence of religions
than the stronger. And given how women are, if they were
left
to their own devices, they would consistently create out of
their weakness not only "men" but also "gods" – and both,
one would presume, would resemble one another –: as monsters
of power!

1 [u

I.

131

On Women.

Female judgment and women's faith in (superstition
about) the accuracy of their judgment.

Fem(ale) assessment of the affects,
of the individual virtues and vices,

. Fem(ale) judgment concerning

men and women, state and nature, work, leisure, etc.

. In what way they feel obligated to claim as real
something they nevertheless know to be unreal.

Io.

. Child raising partly educationally regressive and
retarding, partly all too deinfantilizing. (fem(ale)
rationalism)

To what extent women treat men like children.

. To what extent women seduce others into holding them
in high regard and
nevertheless bow before this regard (as before an
authority)

. The history of what is perceived by women to be
unwomanly, – according to peoples and prevailing
customs.

The fem(ale) faith in some supreme fem(ale) virtue,
which must exist, so that a superior nature of
women may be achieved – and the act(ual) change
of these "supreme virtues."

1 JULY-AUGUST 1882 33

u. Feeling of perfection and completion of her being e.g., while serving, obeying

12. Pregnancy as the quintessential condition, which has gradually, in the course of time, fixed the essence of women. Relation of all modes of female thought and action to this.

13. Denying, destroying, being alone, fighting, despising, taking revenge: why women are more barbaric in all of these things than men etc. etc. etc.

[2 = N V 9b. Summer–Autumn 1882]

2 [1]! Metteyya

2 [2] Carus, vergl(eichende) Psychologie?

2 [3]? Vogt? 19185 Lindau? 18772 Wilbrandt® 18761

2 [4]

The morality of the chosen or the free morality.

We as the preservers of life.

Inevitably contempt and hatred for life are emerging.

Buddhism.

The European drive to achieve will cause mass-suicide. In that

regard: my theory of recurrence as the most terrible burden.

If we do not survive, then everything is finished. Our survival by means of an organization.

The friends of life.

Nihilism as a small prelude.

Impossibility of philosophy.

Just as Buddhism makes us unproductive and good, so under its influence Europe also grows: tired!

2 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 35

Good people, this is the weariness.

Reconciliation, this is the weariness.

Morality, this is the weariness.

Proper customs (e.g., marriage) this is the weariness.

Against idealists.

2 [5] That which is to come.

True striving into nothingness.

Wars over the principle of better-not-to-be-than-to-be.

(A)

First consequence of morality: life is to be denied.

Last consequence of morality = morality itself is to be denied.

(B)

Therefore: the first consequence falls away

liberation of selfishness, liberation of evil, liberation of the individual.

The new good people ("I will this") and the old good people

("I should").

Liberation of art as rejection of unconditional knowledge.

Praise of the lie.

Reclaiming religion.

(C)

Through all this liberation the allure of life continues to grow. Life's innermost denial, moral denial, is set aside. – And with this the downfall begins. The necessity of barbarism, to which, e.g., religion also belongs. Humankind must live in cycles, the only lasting form. Not the longest lasting

culture, but as brief and high as possible. – We at noon: epoch.

(D)

What determines the highest of heights in the history of culture?

The moment when the allure is the greatest. Measured by the fact that the mightiest thought is borne, yes even loved.

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2 [6] That which isto come.

A Prophecy.

A. Victory of morality over itself.

B. Liberation.

C. Middle and beginning of the downfall.

D. Characteristic features of noon. E. Freely-chosen death.

2 [7]

Serpent, spoke Zarathustra, you are the most clever animal under the sun – you will know what strengthens a heart – my clever heart – I do not know. And you, eagle, you are the proudest animal under the sun, take my heart and carry it wherever it demands – my proud heart – I do not know.

2 [8]8

P(eople) who do not need to lie a lot make much of the fact that they only lie a little.

2 [9]

And yet proclaim to me, you animals: Is the sun already at its noon height? Is the serpent called eternity already coiling

itself? Zarathustra goes blind.!

For me everything always turns to death. Who wants to be my destiny? I love every destiny. Zarathustra grows blissful!

Zarathustra knows nothing more, Zarathustra deciphers nothing more.

2 [10]

Always give back: never accept anything as a gift, other than

as a commendation and as a sign that we recognize those who love others by such signs and compensate through our love.!!

2 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 37

2 [11]

Taking away morality from humans because they are making such poor use of it: and forcing brutal feelings into them –

“thou shalt” – like soldiers –

2 [12]

Commit yourself to something e.g., “I want to be just.”

Only one sin: cowardice.

2 [3]**

Lack of love likes to disguise itself as the absence of some-

one worth loving.

2 [14]?

A man uses love to search for an unconditional slave, a woman for unconditional slavery – love is the longing for a vanished culture and society.

2 [ss]

When faced with independent people who hate being bell-wethers, the moral person harbors a suspicion that they could

be wide-rang(ing) predators.

2 [16]'4

Iron hates the magnet when the m(agnet) can't draw it completely toward itself. 2 [17]®

What we hate the most is not what keeps us from being loved, but what keeps us from loving fully.

2 [18]!°

Those who conceal nothing about themselves provoke outrage.

38 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

2 [19]!"

“Unfortunate one, your God has burst and shattered, and serpents dwell within him. And now for his sake you love even

these serpents.”

2 [20]"8

We do not want to be spared by our enemies – any more than we want to be spared by those we love deeply.

2 [21]?

Watch out for that one: he speaks only so that he may listen afterwards: – and you only listen because it will not do to keep speaking forever – i.e., you listen badly and that one

listens well.

2 [22]°°

That bitch sensuality, who only wants to carve herself a bite of flesh, knows all too well how to beg for a bite of spirit.

2 [23]"

It never gives, it does not even pay back – it only replies.

2 [24]

There are natures that give, there are those that give back.

2 [25]?

It is impossible to give gifts to truly just people – they give everything back.

2 [26]?

In the communication of knowledge there is always some betrayal.

24 2 [27]

There is shamelessness in all writing.

2 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 39

2 [28]

Anyone who loves God chastises him.

2 [29]°°

Superficial people always have to lie because they have no substance.

2130]?

To educate: i.e., educating someone to lie in all circumstances.

2[31]°®

Those who are truthful end up realizing that they always lie.

2[32]"

Those who lie contradict not only what they know, but also what they don't know.

2[33]°°

It is nobler to admit wrong than to be in the right.

2134"

A lie is the philanthropy of the one who knows.

2[35]? Suicide

2[36]°°

Justice only possible with respect to things.

2137]

Our influence as a necessary" deception.

2[38] Injustice shared is justice halved.°°

40 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

2139]

p. 200 Hum(an), All T(oo Human)

p 77 Dawn 167,8 Koyful) Science

2[40]

Terrible consequence, when human beings are loved only for the sake of God.

2[41]°8

"But how could you do such a thing! said a friend to a very clever p(erson) – it was stupid." It hasn't been easy for me either, replied the latter.

2[42]"

Those who want to ascend to ultimate knowledge"? must also leave truthfulness behind. The wall of knowledge'! defi-

nately cannot be scaled from the starting point of morality.

2[43]?

"Life for the sake of knowledge," wanting-to-stand on one's head is perhaps somewhat insane – but when it is a sign of joy, this wanting may continue, it doesn't look so bad an ele(phant* that is trying to stand on its head.)

2[44]*4

The price of a good reputation is usually too high: namely ourselves.

2[45]"

The danger for the wise is that they fall in love with the irrational.

6 2[46]°

Love for a woman! If it is not compassion for a suffering god, then it is an instinct for the beast concealed in women.

2 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 4I

2[47]*"

The touchstone for a person's nature is not the way it loves, but rather how all its vulgarity or superiority comes to light

when it knows that it is loved.

2[48]

I am more surprised by blame than by praise; I have more contempt for praise than for blame.

2[49]*

Mor(al) outrage is the most insidious kind of revenge.

2[50]®

I like compassion only in the faces of the victorious. When these miserable people, whose appearance is painful, even so make compassionate faces, – – –

Compassion may be something for gods, but it suits heroes

better to be cheerful about the misery that surrounds them.

[3 = Z I 1. Summer–Autumn 1882]

On the High Seas. A Book of Sentences by Friedrich Nietzsche.

"That's the way I want to go! And I trust

"Myself from now on and my grip.

"Open is the sea, into the blue

"Sails my Genoese ship.

"Everything becomes new and newer to me,

"Space and time shine far into the distance –

"Hail to you, ship! Hail to your helm!

"Around you roars eternity!" –!?

Silent Speeches A Book of Sentences.

"Beyond Good and Evil."

Book of Sentences.

"il sait gotiter sa vie

en paresseux sense qui pond sur ses plaisirs.'

(Duc de Nevers.)

4

3 SUMMER–AUTUMN 1882 43

1. A: What is the meaning of justice? B: My justice is love with

open eyes. A: But think of what you are saying: this justice would acquit everyone except those who judge! This love bears

not only all punishment but also all guilt! B: This is the way it should be!

2. Becoming youthful late keeps us young longer. We do not have to look for youth among the young.°

3. When talents fade, a person's moral qualities become more visible; and it is not always stars that become more visible with

the approaching night."

for that reason alone look with eagle-eyes for their base y qualities."

5. There is also an intrusiveness in those who know: this intrusiveness is condemned to see only the foreground of all things."

6. When five people speak together, a sixth always has to die.'?

7. God choked to death on theology; and morals on morality.!?

8. Those who have loved humanity the most have always hurt

humanity the most: they have asked the impossible of it, as
all
lovers do.!*

9. So spoke a saint: "I love God – for a human being is too
imperfect a thing. Love for a human being would destroy
me."

10. The time has come when the devil must be God's advo-
cate: at least if he himself wants to continue to exist.!!®

44 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

11. "You have become cold to everything that previously had
value, colder than ice – but those who touch you now claim
that you are red hot: and pull their fingers quickly away in
the

belief that you have burned them. And soon there will be
peo-

ple who seek you out in order to warm themselves on you."!"

12. It is treasonous when someone strives for greatness.

People

of the finest quality strive for something puny."®

13. Those who do not make us fertile will surely leave us
indif-

ferent. Yet making others fertile does not come close to
giving

us a reason for loving them."

14. The third person is always the cork that keeps the con-
ver-

sation of two from sinking into the depths: which in certain
circumstances is an advantage."°

15. Throw your words out ahead of your deeds: obligate your-
self through your shame for the broken word.?!

16. It is the way of women to seduce their neighbors"? into
having a high opinion of them and then to believe in this
opin-

ion as if it were an authority."

17. In denying, destroying, hating, taking revenge women are
more barbaric than men."4

18. The sacrifices we offer only prove how much less we come
to value everything else when we love something.

19. Whatever we love to do the most, we would like this to
be

regarded as the thing we find most difficult to do.

20. Behind all their female ambition women still have con-
tempt for "women as such?"

3 SUMMER--AUTUMN 1882 45

21. What we recognize in other people, is also what we
kindle

in them; and anyone who recognizes only the base qualities in people also exerts an attraction on these qualities and brings them to release. The affects of those closest to you that are directed against you are the critique of your knowledge, based on superiority?® and lowliness."?

The deepest love, e.g., does not know what to call itself and

probably is asking itself, "am I not hatred?"?°

23. Masculine and feminine affects differ in their tempo: for

this reason men and women will never stop misunderstanding each other.*!

In getting to know other people better we do not move outside ourselves, but rather ever further into ourselves.

24. We do the same thing awake as we do in our dreams: always, we first invent and poetically imagine the people with whom we associate – and immediately forget that they are invented and poetically imagined.????

26. Emotional needs should not be confused with the need for emotions that several extremely cold people possess."

27. Those who do not need to lie make much of the fact that they do not lie.

28. Women understand children better, but men are more childlike than women.?"

29. People of faith?® find their natural adversaries not in free-

thinkers, but rather in religious people.

46 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

30. Those who create are the most hated: for they are the most

thorough annihilators.*?

31. Phariseeism is not a kind of degeneracy in good people, but rather a condition of their being good."

32. We love life, not because we are alive, but because we are

used to life.*!

33. From time to time even our virtues should be allowed to sleep."

34. You believe in your "life after death"? Then you must learn to be dead during your life.

35. Our flaws are our best teachers: but we are always ungrate-

ful to our best teachers.

36. "Let's not speak of it!" – "My friend, this is something we shouldn't even be quiet about." 44

37. What do people know of love who have not been forced to despise precisely what they have loved!®

38. Seeing beyond ourselves is necessary in order to see well.46

39. "People are not equal!" – So speaks – justice."

We do not believe in many things only because we do not believe in the conventional way they are explained.*®

40. Those who are passionate about justice experience even their most painful affect as a kind of relief.

41. Ponderous, melancholic people become more lighthearted and rise to the surface through the very things that make others

heavy-hearted, like hate and love."

3 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 47

42. Soap bubbles and butterflies and their human equivalents seem to me to know best what happiness is: to see these airy foolish agile dainty little souls fluttering about – this moves

me to tears and poetry."

43. "Did you see your devil?"– "Yes, ponderous serious profound thorough pathetic: he stood there just like the genius gravitationis'' by which all beings and things – fall."

44. Anyone who would have compassion for the entire human race would have to be seen by each individual as hard-hearted and tyrannical.¥

45. A thing that is brought to light" ceases to interest us. So

take care that you don't become too enlightened about yourself!"

46. We must know how to be a sponge if we want to be loved by a person who is filled to overflowing."®

Here lies the most frequent form of dishonesty among those who know: they deny the facts.

47. Anyone who has seen the ideal of a person perceives the real person as its caricature."

48. Some seek a midwife for their thoughts, others someone they can help: this is how a good conversation arises. But watch out if two midwives run into each other! They don't carry forceps for nothing!'

frivolously and more brazenly than those who have no ideal at all'?

50. The devil has the best perspectives on God: that's why he stays so far away from him – he is, after all, a friend of knowledge.

48 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

51. "Should a bond not tear,
You must try biting into it."°!

Marriage, the most dishonest and hypocritical form of sexual relations, may be right for those incapable of either love

or friendship and for those who would like to deceive themselves and others about this deficiency: to this end, state and

religion have declared marriage to be holy, and it also may be

right for those who cannot be disillusioned by marriage because they have no experience in either love or friendship."

52. The danger for the wise is that they are most easily seduced into falling in love with the irrational.

53. Love for a woman! If it is not compassion for a suffering

god, then it is the instinct that seeks the beast concealed in

women."

55. To remain cheerful amid universal misery defines heroes: and not out of compassion, but out of abundance, they reward others and "sacrifice themselves," – as we say.°°

56. Self-interest and passion are married to each other: this

marriage is called selfishness: this unhappy marriage!

57. What? you do not want to be judged by your effect, but rather by your intentions? But your intentions are themselves

derived from your effect."

58. Anything questioned for a long time becomes questionable.°®

59. Terrible experiences lead us to speculate whether those who experience them aren't also something terrible: maybe even without knowing it.

3 SUMMER–AUTUMN 1882 49

60. Marriage is the most dishonest form of sexual relations; and for that very reason has good conscience on its side.'

61. We usually sacrifice too much for our good reputation: namely ourselves."!

Those wanting to become leaders must want to be regarded by their followers, for a while at least, as their most dan-

gerous
enemy.'?

62. People will chase after anyone who knows how to deceive them into thinking they have lost their way: it flatters them so

much to hear that they have a way at all.'?"

63. The great thoughts that come "from the heart," the petty ones that come from the underbelly: both are badly conceived."4

64. "Great thoughts"? My friend, those are thoughts that puff

you up and make you big: a windbag is not great!'

It is not how people love that reveals either the vulgarity or

the superiority of their inner nature – for love is in all respects

much more of a liar than a traitor! But it pays to look more closely at how people behave when they are loved! – And for a few who had reason to remain unknown, it was a subtle aspect of their destiny never to be loved."

65. Life for the sake of knowledge is perhaps an insane thing:

but still a sign of exhilaration. Watching someone who wants it is about as amusing as watching an elephant that tries to stand on its head.'"

66. "But how could you do such a thing! – said a friend to a very clever person – it was stupid!" – It hasn't been easy for

me either, replied the latter.'

50 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

67. Jesus of Nazareth loved evil people, but not good people:

the sight of their moral outrage moved even him to curses.

Wherever judgments were rendered, he sided against those judging: he wanted to be the annihilator of morality.

68. Jesus said to the people: "love God as I love him, as his

son: what do we sons of God care about morality!"

69. You think you seek "the truth"! You seek a leader and what you really want is to have someone command you!

70. Why so apart? – "I found no person I could still obey and no one I would like to command."®°

72. Love brings to light the lofty and rare qualities in people;

in this way love is deceptive about them (most of all to them-

selves). But anyone who does not want to be deceived, pay attention to what happens when people know themselves to be loved but do not love: there the soul unwillingly reveals its sediments. 8

73. No one has ever arrived at complete knowledge by means of truthfulness.°%\$%

74. We have rendered lightning harmless: but that is not enough, it should also learn to work on our behalf. – This is how I think of all the “evil” in you and me.

75. The Christian god, the god of love and cruelty, is a person who has been conceived very cleverly and without moral prejudice: just the right God for Europeans who want to subjugate the earth.

3 SUMMER–AUTUMN 1882 51

76. Whatever a particular era perceives to be evil, wherever it recognizes a contradiction with its ideal, is in truth only an echo of what earlier times have held to be good and, as it were, the atavism of an older ideal. Original sin – this is in all circumstances = original virtue.3°

78. When we have raised ourselves above good and evil, we see merely unintended comedy even in tragedy.°®

79. Philosophical systems are the most mundane form through which some people can talk about themselves – an unclear and stammering form of memoir.®?

80. To see tragic natures perish and still be able to laugh, surpassing the deepest understanding, feeling and compassion for them – is divine.

81. “There is no doubt that much lying and deceiving is done by those who believe in this cause: therefore everything about this cause is deception and lies” – this is the conclusion drawn by superficial people. But anyone who knows humans more deeply will draw the reverse conclusion: “therefore there must be something true about this cause: its believers only reveal

through this

how secure they feel and how for them any bait will do, as long

as it is effective in luring someone to their cause."

83. It is essential to have seen someone asleep: otherwise it is

impossible to know how that person looks. The face of your best friend that you think you know is your face in an imperfect and roughly polished mirror.?!

52 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

84. What difference does it make whether you are flattering a

god or a devil, or whether you are whining to a god or a devil?

You are merely flatterers and whiners!??

85. Anyone who is a coward through and through is usually clever enough to take on so-called lovable qualities."

86. The consequences of our actions grab us by the scruff of the neck," quite indifferent to the fact that we have "bettered"

ourselves in the meantime."

87. Commanding people will also command their God, however much they believe they are serving him.

88. A supremely moral mendacity would be conceivable by which people become aware of their sexual drive merely as the

obligation to produce children.

89. He calls it party loyalty: but it is only his complacency

which no longer lets him climb out of this bed.

90. When a particular virtue finally becomes habitual for us,

we should at least have the good taste no longer to call it virt-

ue, but rather "taste."

92. When the compassionate become shameless and tell us compassion is virtue itself: then they arouse our compassion.?"

93. Noble human beings always stand in the way of good people: the good often marginalize them merely by saying that they are good."

94. In the presence of a hero everything turns into tragedy; in

the presence of a demigod – everything turns into satyr play."?

3 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 53

96. Criminals are treated by moral people as an appendage!" to a single action'®!— and criminals treat themselves the same way, especially if this single action was the exception in their existence: it works like a chalk line drawn around a hen.!°?

—
In the world of morality there is a lot of hypnotism.!°

97. You call them "lofty feelings," "sublime mentality": I see nothing more than lust for the heights and the spasms of a moral ambition.

98. Your stride reveals that you are not yet walking your path, your eagerness to dance would have to be evident. Dance is the proof of truth.!®

99. "Serious," "strict," "moral" — that's what you call him. To me he seems evil and unjust to himself, always ready to punish us for that and to play our executioner — and indignant that we do not allow it.

100. "Lofty feelings!" — Upon the heights there is no feeling of elevation, but rather of depths and of finally reaching solid ground for the first time: as long as the innocence of heights has really been attained.

101. By being willing to help, by commiserating, by subjugating themselves, by forgoing personal demands, even insignificant

and superficial people may become somewhat bearable to look at: indeed they should not be disabused of the notion that this willingness to help is "virtue itself."

102. Morality is now the excuse for superfluous and random people, for worms that are weak in body and spirit who should

not be alive — In this respect morality is mercy: for it says to

everyone "you are really something very important": which of course is a lie.

54 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

103. That "a foolish woman with a good heart stands high above any genius," this sounds very good — in the mouth of a genius. It is his way of being polite — it is also a sign of his

cleverness.

104. We do not find the vanity of others distasteful until it

competes with our own.!

106. The natural consequences of an act are seldom deliberated as long as such consequences include public punishment and denunciation. Here flows the great spring of all super-

ficiality.

107. Women direct their love toward those who inspire fear in

them: this is their kind of bravery.!!°8

108. "One person is really still too many to have around"!

– thinks the solitary person. One times one is two.!!°

109. We love utility only as the vehicle for our inclinations:

and actually find the noise of its wheels intolerable.!!!

110. "Just being yourself": this may be the distinction we reserve

for our best friend – with the result that they wish we would go

to the devil."!

1. People may often be equal to what they do but not to their image of what they've done.!!?

112. The most beautiful colors with which the virtues shine are the invention of those who lacked them. For example, where does the velvet sheen of goodness and compassion come from? – Certainly not from good and compassionate people.

3 SUMMER–AUTUMN 1882 55

113. Only great criminals have any significance in world history,

including those many who were capable of a serious crime but through some chance did not commit it.

" . ny « » C . » « a . nD C »

114. "Religious person," "fool," "genius," "criminal," "tyrant

– these are pejorative names and details in place of something unnamable.

115. Bad conscience is the tax that the invention of good con-

science levies on human beings.

116. You want to be just? Unfortunate one, how do you propose to give to each his own? – No, I don't want that. I will

give to each my own: '* that will be enough for everyone except

the wealthiest people.!!°

117. Solitude makes us harder on ourselves and makes us yearn more for people: it builds character through both.

118. People are strictest with their God: he is not allowed to sin!"

God devised the teleology of pregnancy: then he devised women.

119. "I do not believe in anything anymore." – This is the proper mindset for a creative person.

120. La Rochefoucauld stopped halfway: he denied the "good" qualities of human beings – he should have denied the "evil" ones as well.

When moral skeptics have reached the point of mistrusting morality, then they still have one more step to take – skepticism of their mistrust. Denial and trust – here they shake hands.

56 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

121. Belief inside the form, disbelief inside the content – here

lies the allure of the maxim – therefore a moral paradox.

122. We forgive our opponents most completely their – failures.'!"

123. What? You want to know yourself? Learn rather to know what makes you happy!

124. I want wishes, nothing but wishes: and always a new wish instead of fulfillment.!!8

125. The most expensive luxury that humanity has so far bestowed

upon itself is the belief in something unreal, in selflessness. For this

devalued what is most real, selfishness. – Since then all happiness is yearning!"

126. Intense hatred is also an idealist: whether in hating we

transform our opponents into gods or into devils, either way we give them too much credit.

127. Even in hatred there is jealousy: we want to have our enemy for ourselves alone.

128. The solution for the riddle "woman" is not love but pregnancy.!?°

129. Our faith in others reveals where we would like to have

faith in ourselves.!?!

130. "The heart is one of the entrails" – Napoleon once said.

The entrails of the head lie in the heart.!??

131. Every strong expectation outlives its fulfillment when the

fulfillment comes sooner than expected. This friend arrived two days too early: his presence is unbelievable to me.

3 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 57

132. Knowledge would have little allure if we did not have to

overcome so much shame on the way to acquiring it.!??

133. "Knowledge for its own sake" – this is the last snare laid

by morality: with this there is once again complete entangle-

ment in morality.!?*

"All women!? are either birds or cats or cows" – the look in their eyes shows which one.!?°

What is the best life? To be tickled to death.

135. "Morality itself was the first fall into sin: morality itself is

the original sin" – everyone who knows thinks this way.

136. He has learned to express himself – but since then he is

no longer believed. Only those who stammer are believed.

139. We do not believe that cold people are capable of foolishness.!?°

I spit on the educated rabble who are ashamed to say to themselves: "Here I feel nothing!" "Here I know nothing."

The one who knows lives among human beings not as if among animals, but rather as among animals.'?!

140. The inclination toward the tragic increases or decreases

along with sensuality: it is part of every adolescence and young

manhood.!"

58 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

141. There is much more intrusiveness in praise than in blame.!?3

142. Abundant good will to live – but too little will to suffer

– this is what makes people complacent.!?*

143. Objections, mistrust, infidelity are signs of health: all

unconditional striving is a kind of pathology.!?

144. Anyone who feels the unfreedom of the will is mentally ill; anyone who denies it is stupid.

145. What is done out of love, this is not moral, but rather religious.

146. It is not enough to have talent: we must also be allowed to have it.!?6

147. Be wary of people with moral outrage: they have a stinger-like cowardly viciousness that they conceal from themselves.

148. The Christian God who is "love" emerged at a time when love was still not divine enough.

149. Good and evil people – it's all the same to me: but I despise cowardly and loveable people.!?7

The strength of good people does not lie in their goodness, but rather in the fact that their evil is strong.

150. Those who are teachers through and through only take seriously those things that have to do with their students – even themselves.!?8

151. "At least be my enemy": thus speaks true reverence, which does not dare beg for friendship.!?9

3 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 59

If you do not inspire fear in the first place and in all circumstances, then no one will take you seriously enough to finally come to love you.

152. All rights of ownership cease to apply for the one who knows.

When good people moralize, they arouse disgust: when evil people moralize, they arouse fear.

153. The intoxication of victory is always followed by a feeling of great loss: our enemy, our enemy is dead! We mourn even the loss of a friend less deeply – and therefore more loudly!

154. People of knowledge must not only love their enemies but also be able to hate their friends.!?*

155. It is in poor taste when people of knowledge make themselves out to be "moral people": anyone looking at them should be able to tell that they "have no need" of morality.

156. Everything about him is ripe for the harvest: but he lacks the sickle – and so he rips off the tassels and is annoyed.!

4!

157. Some travel in order to find themselves, others because they would like to lose themselves.

159. Insanity seldom occurs in individuals – but in groups, political parties, peoples, ages, it is the rule: – and that's why

historians have yet to speak of insanity. But at some point physicians will write history.!*

160. When we love we create people in the image of our God: only then do we begin to hate our devil most completely.

60 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

161. It is not easy to find a book that would teach us as much

as the book we produce.

162. Those who know "readers" certainly don't write for read-

ers any more – but rather for themselves, the writers.!*

163. In the mountains the shortest route leads from peak to peak: but for that you need long legs! – Maxims are peaks.!*

*°

164. It is not enough to make amends for something, we must also remake ourselves, be good to ourselves again, for example,

by means of some small, superfluous mischief or good deed.!*

4"

165. Giving to each his own: that would mean wanting justice and achieving chaos.

166. Here both these people have basically the same bad taste:

but one of them would like to convince himself!* and us, too,

that his is the best. And the other is ashamed of his taste and

would like to convince himself and us, too, that he has a different

and better kind of taste – ours. All intellectual philis-

tines belong to one of these two types.

When people freely take suffering upon themselves, they also have the free will to do themselves good: and whoever denies this – – –

167. Beware of good people, the eternal Pharisees, practicing

history! They paint over the great people of the past until they

look just as fat and well-behaved as good people."

Morality struts around pretending to be the antagonist of evil – – –

168. Another century of newspapers – and all words will stink. 150151

3 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 61

169. The one who knows dislikes wading into the water of truth, not when it is dirty, but when it is shallow.!??

170. To skeptics. – Those who grow too tired eventually lie down to sleep even in the snow – take care not to go too far.”

171. Anyone who climbs high mountains laughs at all tragic gestures. !>4

172. The air thin and pure, danger nearby – and the spirit full of cheerful malice: they go well together.’

It is a good way of getting through the “evil night.”!>”

175. There are feelings that want to kill us; but if they don’t

succeed, they must die themselves.’58

176. Not only our reason, but our conscience, too, submits to

our strongest drive, the tyrant within us. If we possess no such

tyrant among our drives, then our individual drives compete for

the favor of reason just as much as for the favor of conscience

– and reason and conscience become almost sovereign.!°?

177. Those who commit suicide among us are giving suicide a bad name – not the other way around!!°®

178. It is nobler to admit wrong than to insist on being in the

right – especially when you are right.!°!

62 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

180. Those who are truthful end up realizing that they always lie?

181. As in the case of the hypnotized, in many women! the intellect only appears suddenly and sporadically and with un-

expected force: the spirit then comes “over them” and apparently not out of them. Hence their three-eyed® cleverness in

interrelated matters – hence also their faith in inspiration.

182. There is much about evil people that disgusts me, but also much about good people: and, truly, it has nothing to

do

with their "evil"!!66

183. "It is not enough to punish criminals, we should also reconcile with them and bless them: or did we not love them as we caused them pain? (Did we not) suffer by being forced to

use them as a means of deterrence?"!°7

184. Wherever friendship just won't turn into love, isn't the

reason a natural opposition like that between dogs and cats?

185. We must repay good and bad things: but why particularly to the person who has done something good or bad to us?!°®

186. A punishment should be devised in such a way that after a violation we will accept it as our right and our honor.!®

187. Lying involves contradicting what you know, but even more so contradicting what you don't know. – The second kind of lie is so common that it is no longer a stumbling block:

human interaction is shaped by it.!7°

3 SUMMER–AUTUMN 1882 63

190. It is impossible to give gifts to truly just people: they give

everything back. Which is why those who love them find them horrifying.'

191. We no longer love our knowledge enough as soon as we communicate it.!7*

192. That bitch sensuality, who only wants to carve herself a

piece of flesh, knows all too well how to beg for a piece of spirit.!75

193. Poets are shameless about their experiences; they exploit them!"6

194. Whether you betray yourself or me, you are a traitor. 70

writers."

195. Watch out for that one: he speaks only so he will be allowed

to listen afterwards – and you listen only because it will not

do to keep talking forever: i.e., you listen badly and he listens

only too well.'78

196. We do not want to be spared by our true enemies: any more than we want to be spared by those whom we love deeply!"?

197. Unfortunate one, your God has burst and shattered, and the serpents dwell within him – and now for his sake you still love even these serpents!.'@°

198. Those who conceal nothing about themselves provoke outrage.'?!

199. Iron hates the magnet when the magnet can't draw it completely toward itself – and yet still attracts.'@?

64 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

200. Not what keeps us from being loved, but what keeps us from loving fully, is what we hate the most.!??

The thing we hate about our neighbors is that they cannot have our ideals.

201. When we become tired of ourselves and no longer like to love (ourselves), then loving thy neighbor is advisable as a cure: insofar as our neighbors will very soon require that we

believe in our own "lovability."

202. "Our neighbor doesn't live in the neighborhood": this is

how all politicians and peoples think.!*4

203. This virtue would lead to your downfall, my friend: but heaven gave you a second virtue, which sometimes makes you unfaithful to the first.

204. Through loving someone we want to get past our envy of that person.!8°

205. We all pretend to be more naive than we are – and in fact even to ourselves.!8°

206. Substantial obligations don't make us grateful but vengeful.!87

207. We like to call in witnesses when we want to talk about ourselves: this is what is called "human interaction."!88

208. We grow accustomed to scorning evil when we live only in the company of weak and petty people: evil in great people

has something inspiring about it.

209. Lack of love likes to disguise itself as the absence of someone worth loving.'@?

3 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 65

210. A man uses love to search for an unconditional slave, a woman for unconditional slavery – love is the longing for a vanished culture and society – it harkens back to the Orient.!"°

211. Injustice should only be taken on by someone who can bear it: that's what humaneness calls for.!!?

The most poisonous arrows are shot at a friend who severs ties without even giving insult.

213. After a break-up. – “Say what you will to hurt me: you know me too little to know what will hurt me most.”

214. Monogamous love is a kind of barbarism, perpetrated at the expense of all others and damaging to knowledge. Rather, you should love many: – then love forces you to be just to each lover: and thus to know each lover. Loving many is the way to knowledge.’

215. The cruelty of those who feel nothing is the opposite of compassion; the cruelty of those full of feeling is compassion raised to a higher power.

216. What we have learned to believe without justification is

the hardest thing to unsettle by means of reasons.!?®

217. Anyone who is chaste by nature does not think highly of chastity, with the exception of a few vain fools. Their idolizers

are those who have reason to wish that they could be or could

have been chaste – the swine of Circe.

218. Certainly, anyone who finds chastity very difficult should

certainly also be advised against it.!?°

66 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

219. Needs of the heart. – Animals that go into heat do not so

easily confuse what is in their hearts with their lust: in the way

that people and especially females!%° do.

220. A woman doesn’t want to admit to herself how much

“ . » . .

manliness” (any manliness) she really loves in her beloved: that’s why she idolizes “the humanity” in him – to herself and to others.

The “I” subjugates robs kills and commits every act of violence: by doing all of that it wants nothing but to nurture

its pregnancy: so that it may bear a god and see all of human-

kind at its feet.!?°

221. With these people, what is fabricated is not their outward

appearance but rather their inner world: they abhor appearing

to be semblance and surface, but that is what they are.!8

222. Heroic humans with knowledge deify their devil: and in the process experience what it is to be a heretic witch prophet, skeptic, sage, to be inspired and overwhelmed, and drown at last in their own ocean.!?

223. Once we have the will to suffer, then we are just one step away from having the will to cruelty – and in fact as a right as well as a duty.”

224. It takes along time to die for the second time: this is true of everyone who has come back to life after death.?”!

225. Even when a people goes backwards, it is pursuing an ideal: it always believes in a forward.”

226. The tendency to let ourselves be disparaged, robbed lied to and exploited, in short, humility can be the shame of a god among humans.”

3 SUMMER–AUTUMN 1882 67

227. Anyone who, like a god, creates a new good has always been taken for a devil by the guardians of the old good.

228. Only vice-ridden people are unhappy when their need for vice merges with their disgust with vice – and their disgust never outgrows their need.

229. We have been poor observers of life if we have failed to notice the hand that in a merciful way – wanted to kill.2°% It is not everything you have done in life but rather your accompanying opinion of what was done that determines whether you now feel satisfied or dissatisfied with yourself.

230. A little revenge is in most cases more humane than no revenge at all.

231. Those who despise themselves nevertheless still flatter themselves with the thought that at least now they are not lying to themselves.

232. Friend, everything you have loved has disappointed you: this disappointment has in the end become your habit: and your last love, which you call the “love of truth,” is perhaps just the love of disappointment.

232. The inability to lie is in no way the same as the love

of

truth. In fact, in every love there is the ability to lie – in the

love of truth as well.

233. He shakes himself, looks around, runs his hand over the top of his head – and he is always called someone who knows. But freedom from fever is still not knowledge.”

68 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

234. “Where is there an ocean in which it is really still possible to drown? namely, a human being!” – this cry resounds

through our time.°°

Possessing the truth is not awful, just tiresome, like every possession.

235. Malice is where presumptuous and weak people meet: but they misunderstand one another.”

236. Those who feel an aversion to the sublime regard not only a yes but also even a no as too overwrought: – they are not to be counted among negative people, and whenever they stray onto this path, they stop abruptly and flee – into the bushes of skepticism.

237. In battle we obviously risk our lives; but the victors are

tempted to throw their lives away. In every victory there is contempt for life.

238. “I do not shun human contact: it is precisely the distance, the eternal distance between any two human beings that drives me into solitude.”

Insatiable need for something and at the same time disgust toward that thing – this is what constitutes the feeling of

those who are vice-ridden.

239. Even truth, like all women, demands of her lovers that they become liars on her behalf – yet it is not her vanity that

demand this, but rather her cruelty.

240. “I did that,” says my memory; “I could not have done that” says my pride and remains adamant. In the end, memory gives in – 708

3 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 69

241. To look at things coldly, so that they lie there naked and

without plumage, – this is called “love of truth,” and is only

the incapacity to lie.”

242. Those who are sick with fever see only ghosts of

things,
and those without fever see only shadows of things: and both
require the same words."!°

243. "I listened for an echo – and I heard only praise."?!!

244. Discovering that we are loved in return should actually
have a sobering effect upon us with regard to the being that
is
loved: how can this being be so foolish as to believe in
you?!"

245. "Why is it always necessary also to hate whatever must
be loved? Is not love the greatest of all agonies?" That is
why
humans must be overcome.?!?

246. If you have seen the dull indifference with which the
black man endures the kind of severe internal illnesses that
would almost certainly bring you to despair: this should
cause

you to consider just how little pain is really present in
human-

kind, aside from the ten thousand people who have superior
spirits. 214

247. "My happiness begins when I see myself beneath myself,
as a being among other beings."

248. Our era is a tumultuous era, and for that reason not an
era

of passion; it keeps itself constantly overheated because it
senses

that it is not warm – basically, it is freezing. I do not
believe in

the greatness of all of these "great events" you speak of.

79 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

250. These days events do not acquire greatness until there
is

an echo – the echo of newspapers."

251. Poor artists! So what does the nervous rabble demand of
you? It does not wish to be reeducated but rather to be
amazed !?!7

252. Not the intensity but rather the duration of lofty
feel-

ing?!® makes superior human beings: they should not be con-
fused with human beings who are having moral spasms!?!?

253. And once again. – Honest with ourselves and with any-
one else who is a friend to us, courageous against the en-
emy,

generous to the vanquished, courteous to all.??°

254. Those who have no will of their own want at the very

least to be know-it-alls.

255. Originally herds and herd-instinct; the self as exception,

perceived by the herd as nonsense, madness.

256. The sage as astronomer. – As long as you feel the stars as

something “above you,”??! you still lack the knowing gaze: there is no longer any above and below with respect to knowledge.???

257. It is possible to be so closely related to someone that in

our dreams we see them doing and suffering everything they really do and suffer: because it would be possible to do and suffer the same thing ourselves.

258. Those who have character also have their typical experience that always recurs.???

People fall into two categories, those who are capable of

terrible deeds and those who are not.

3 SUMMER–AUTUMN 1882 71

259. There are two fundamentally different kinds of people: the ones who feel ashamed about the ebb of their feelings (in

friendship or love), and the ones who are ashamed of the flood.

Precisely because one lover’s passion reaches its climax and recedes, the growing passion of the other lover tends to last somewhat longer than it would have otherwise: the curve of the longer-lasting lover.”

260. Whether people count as good or evil is in no way determined

by their actions, – but rather by their opinion about these actions.??

261. Only when selfishness has become greater cleverer subtler

more inventive, will the world begin to look “more selfless.”

262. Anyone who can meet the eye of a thinker directly is struck by the kind of horrible impression that some creatures

make when their eyes slowly extend out of their heads, as if on

stalks, as they look around.

263. Even saints require the annihilation of morality: so that

they can do whatever they want.

264. Those who attain their ideal are thereby already –
tran-
scending it.??°

265. People of genius are intolerable unless they possess at least two qualities: gratitude and purity.

266. That which love gives can never be given back and recip-
rocated: any drive to reciprocate should be drowned in the ocean of love.

267. Why would you want to treat me justly? – said the saint. I already embrace your injustice as my due.??7

72 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

268. At the sight of the sublime, sublime humans become free, firm, expansive, serene, cheerful: but the sight of the perfectly beautiful jolts them and bowls them over: in its presence

they negate themselves.

269. Anyone who does not feel at home in the sublime will perceive the sublime as something uncanny and false.

270. Many a peacock hides its tail from all eyes: and calls this

its “pride.”?78

271. Strange! As soon as I want to conceal a thought from myself and keep it at a distance, then you can be sure that this

thought will approach me in bodily form, as a person, and now I must deal deftly with this “angel of God”!

272. To offer blessings when we are cursed is inhuman. So better to join in the cursing for a bit!?”

273. I have seen the triumph of many a truth, but never with-

out the well-meaning support of a hundred errors.?°°

274. Whenever skepticism and yearning mate, mysticism emerges.

Those whose thought has crossed over into mysticism, even once, do not escape without a stigma on all their thoughts.

275. Degree and kind of a person’s sexuality reach up to the highest pinnacle of that person’s intellect. 231232

276. With our principles we want to tyrannize our habits, or to justify, or to venerate, or to castigate, or to conceal them.

Nevertheless, people with the same principles probably want to use them for something completely different.???

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277. Will – this is an assumption which to me explains nothing. For the one who knows, there is no willing.

278. We have yet to see La Rochefoucauld inverted: someone who shows how the vanity and selfishness of good people have twisted certain human qualities and in the end have rendered them – evil and harmful.

279. Do not repay evil with good: for this would shame the recipient, but rather show that something good was done to you.²³⁴

280. All admiration involves some fearing and running away from ourselves – yes, with even some self-denial, self-disavowal mixed in.

281. Those who despise themselves may want consider that they are not only despised but also despising: they may thus admire themselves as despisers!??°

282. In so much as you know what you do, you are blessed. In so much as you do not know, you are cursed and a sinner before the law – said Jesus to someone who broke the Sabbath – advice for all breakers and lawbreakers.??°

283. A sudden outburst of revulsion toward ourselves can just as well be the result of a more refined taste – as of a corrupted taste.

284. “Will to truth!” Let us stop speaking so simplistically and bombastically! We want to make the world conceivable to ourselves, to make it observable where possible – yes, to make!

– All of physics is directed toward making-observable.

74 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

285. Will and intellect (or, as is said, heart and head) – this is man and woman; their interactions always have something to do with love, procreation, pregnancy. And mind you, the heart is in this case the man and the head the woman!

286. He is alone and has nothing but his thoughts: it is no wonder that he often caresses them and teases them and tweaks their ears! – But you rubes say that he is a skeptic.

287. “God’s love for humans is his hell” – said the devil. “But how is it possible to ever fall in love with humans in the first place!”²³⁷

288. In routinely conditioning ourselves to tolerate the

pres-

ence of all kinds of fellow humans, we unconsciously condition ourselves to tolerate our own presence: which is actually

humanity's most incomprehensible achievement.

289. The magnitude of human egoism is not the sword that hangs over humankind, but rather the reverse, the feebleness of its egoism, whereby humankind could too easily become fed up with itself.

290. Under peaceful conditions warlike people attack themselves – for lack of other enemies.*®

291. To create: this means to move something out of ourselves, to make ourselves emptier, poorer and more loving. Once God created the world, he became nothing more than a hollow concept – and love for what was created.

292. "Here is the island of the solitary one. And here I wel-

come everything that is becoming wandering seeking fleeing! Hospitality is my only remaining form of friendship! I love all

that becomes!"

3 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 75

293. The love of life is almost the antithesis of the love of a

long life. All love thinks of the moment and of eternity – but

never of "the length."

294. "My love is so demanding that it instills fear! I cannot

love without believing that the one whom I love is destined to

do something immortal. And he guesses what I believe – what I demand!"

295. Those who know avoid self-knowledge and let their roots sink into the earth.

296. The most comprehensible part of language is not the word

itself, but rather tone, force, modulation, tempo, with which a

series of words is spoken – in short, the music behind the words, the passion behind this music, the person behind this passion: thus all of those things that cannot be written. So there

is no point in being a scribbler.

297. Gait and kind of gait. – I learned to walk: since then I

have allowed myself to run.???

298. The free spirit. – Those who can fly know that they do not

have to be given a push in order to take off; as all you entrenched

spirits need to do in order to “progress” at all.?4°

299. To be ashamed of our immorality: this is a step on the way that ends with being ashamed of our morality as well.?4!

300. We reserve our most profound and enduring love for our children or our works alone: and our love for ourselves is al-

ways a symptom.?*?

301. We will never discover some natures unless we first invent

them.?4?

76 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

302. “Human interaction corrupts character, particularly when

character is absent” – Timon said.?*?

303. “You know nothing about w(omen): how is it that sometimes you are right about them?” With w(omen) nothing is impossible.74

305. Whoever writes maxims does not want to be read, but rather to be memorized.?*°

306. Most humans?” act like cattle in a herd and not like persons especially when satisfying their lust (for food women

possessions, honor power) – even when they are persons.

307. Everything turns out the best for me: who has the desire

to be my destiny? I love every destiny.?“

308. The age of greatest events will in spite of everything be

the age of smallest effects if people are made of rubber and all

too elastic.

309. “Before every action I am tormented by the fact that I am only a dice player – I no longer know anything about freedom of the will. And after every action I am tormented by

the fact that the dice fall in my favor: am I then a cheat-er?”

– Scruples of the one who knows.”

310. Unlearning revenge would also have to mean unlearning gratitude, but not love.

311. Wanting-to-love reveals weariness with the self and

pure

satiation, yet wanting-to-be-loved reveals demand-for-self, selfishness. Lovers give themselves away; those who want to be

loved would like to receive a gift of themselves.

3 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 77

312. The reasons used to justify the punishment for a crime can also be used to justify the crime.

313. Maturity in a man: this means to have rediscovered the seriousness that we had as children at play.?°

"Ella guardava suso, ed io in lei"?! Dante. And I in her!??2

314. I've never been lonely before: I felt a longing for people, I

looked for people – always I found only myself – and now I no longer feel a longing for myself!

Puny people are incapable of evil: consequently they are incapable of becoming either good or evil people. (But good is

a kind of diminished evil?)

To want something and to make it happen: is taken to be the mark of strong character. But not to want something in the first place and still to make it happen is characteristic of

the strongest, who feel themselves to be fate made flesh.

Anyone who remains a child forever also remains an innocent egoist and, as the object of envy and hatred for "guilty" egoists, is hated more.

315. I love human beings: and never more so than when I can resist this compulsion."

316. A woman attempts to love whenever she feels compelled to obey and serve: it is her work of art, created so as to bear her

yoke more easily.

317. "Love me!" – a god who speaks with humans like this has gone mad – out of jealousy.?>*

78 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

318. We do not hate something when we think that it is inferior, but only when we think that it is equal or superior.?°

°

320. It is not the criminals' crime, but rather their cowardice

and foolishness after the crime, that allows us to think contemptuously of criminals at all.

temptuously of criminals at all.

321. Evil acquires a bad reputation only after being confused

with what is low and disgusting. Until then it is attractive and encourages imitation.

322. All women for whom sexual satisfaction has been forbidden by customs and shaming find religion to be something irreplaceable, as a more spiritual release of erotic tension.

(323.) My love for human beings ebbs and flows: and every single individual whom I love is only an occasion for this love.

To realize this is depressing.

324. We occasionally embrace an individual out of love for humanity because we cannot embrace everyone: but we should never reveal this to the individual!°°

Good is puny evil: that is why puny people so easily become good people.

325. Those to whom we feel closest are always loved at the expense of those from whom we feel more distant.

"The weaker person is the better person" – say our moralizers.

Weak people say "I have to" strong people "it has to."

3 SUMMER–AUTUMN 1882 79

Women commit ten times fewer crimes than men –

thus they are ten times more moral: according to statistics.

326. The innocence of egoism is characteristic of a child: and

if you do not become like children then you will never enter this heavenly kingdom.*"

327. We should take leave of life the way Odysseus left Nausi-

caa –blessing it more than loving it.°®

328. We do good deeds for our neighbors, but we don't create for them: thus speaks the honesty of all who create.?"

329. The love for those who are distant, those to come, is superior

to loving thy neighbor: and the love for things is superior to all

love for persons."

330. I want to say "enemy," but not "criminal": I want to say

c . » « » KS »

vermin," but not "scoundrel": I want to say "sick," but not "monster"; I want to say "fool," but not "sinner."?!°!

331. Denying procreation to all cowards: this should be the negative morality of women.

332. Solitary people love what it is to be human – but they don't love human beings: and when this love-of-what-it-is-to-

be-human has accumulated and become dammed up within them, it then cascades forth like a torrent on whoever comes to mind, regardless of whether it is an enemy or a friend.

333. You say, "I love myself," "I despise myself," "I pity myself"

– my friend and denier of God, I do not want to challenge your "I," but this myself of yours is just as poetic and invented

as any god – you must deny it, too.

80 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

334. Making compassion and sensitivity toward our neighbor a part of morality (or even morality itself) is a sign of vanity,

assuming we are compassionate and sensitive by nature – which means lacking pride and nobility of soul.

The cult of compassion is only proper for people who did not come to know it from their own experience.

335. If we train our conscience properly, it kisses us at the

same time as it bites.??

336. Morality is the posturing of humans in the face of nature."

337. "Perhaps a devil invented morality in order to torment humans with pride: and then sometime a second devil will take

morality away in order to torment them with self-contempt."

338. "There are no humans, for there was no first human": this

is how animals make inferences.?"4

339. The familiarity of superiors is embittering because it may not

be reciprocated. Courtesy is advisable instead, i.e., the enduring

impression that there might be something for superiors to honor.

340. I do not understand why we find it necessary to slander others. If we want to hurt people, we only need to say something true about them. ?°6

341. We always know a little too much about everyone."

praise, we always praise only our own taste – which also goes

against all good taste.?"®

3 SUMMER –AUTUMN 1882 81

343. Only human beings resist the pull of gravity: they would like to fall constantly – up.

344. The ladder of my feelings is long, and I do not at all mind sitting on its lowermost rungs, precisely because I often have to spend too much time sitting on the highest ones: for there the wind is biting and the light is often too bright.

345. Jealousy is the most inspired passion and nevertheless still the greatest folly.?"

346. Like the scorpion, those who burn with jealousy turn the poisonous stinger against themselves – yet without the scorpion's success.?"°

347. Not that you lied to me, but rather that I no longer believed you, this is what has shaken me.??!

348. I should forgive? But I don't blame you for the same reasons you blame yourself: how could I then forgive you??'?

349. Talking a lot about ourselves is also a means of concealing ourselves.?"?

351. The hatred of evil is a ceremonial robe that Pharisees use to disguise their personal antipathies.'""°

Music is for women?"6 a form of sensuality.

Women are much more sensual than men, precisely because compared to men they become far less aware of sensuality as such.??77

82 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

352. In today's music there is an audible synthesis of religion and sensuality: and consequently more of woman than has ever existed in music before.

I and Me are always two different persons.?"®

353. Ever since I saw the storm-tossed ocean and above it a pure shining sky, I am no longer fond of all the sunless, overcast passions which know no light other than lightning.

354. All successful people understand the difficult art of knowing the right time to – go.?"

Those who give a taste of their minds are liked: but those who devour minds are feared. The moment you are liked, consider how near the moment is when you – –

355. It is not their love of humanity, but rather their impotent love of humanity, that stops today's Christians from erecting stakes for the burning of heretics.2°

356. You believe, so you claim, in the necessity of religion! Be honest! You believe only in the necessity of police and live in fear of robbers and thieves stealing your money and your tranquility!#@!

357. How moral and sublime people become every time they have a good chance of using these qualities to inflict pain!#?

358. Nobility in obedience, freedom under coercion and law, contempt for the rebellious desires of slaves: these are the marks of the first caste "human."

359. Eleven-twelfths of all great men in history were merely representatives of a great cause.

3 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 83

Until now humanity's perception has been too dull to recognize that the most powerful humans were great actors.

360. Only those who dramatize their virtues become famous in their lifetimes."

361. "I don't like him." – Why? – "I am no match for him." – Has any person ever answered in this way??@*

362. When hungry for people we look above all for comfort food, even if it is not especially nourishing: like potatoes.

364.285 Rebellion is the slave's noblest attitude.7*°

365. When you taste best, that is when you must stop letting yourself be eaten – this is the secret of women who are loved for a long time.

366. Dramatizers of greatness who are unaware of their play-acting have the same effect as the truly great and even surpass them – in brilliance.

We always create a distance around ourselves through what we admire and how we admire it.

368. It isn't what he does and how he schemes against me during the day that bothers me: but that I appear in his dreams at night – gives me chills.7%°

369. Through music the affects take pleasure in themselves."*

impervious to even the best rational objections once a decision

has been made: in other words, a periodic madness.?"°

84 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

371. "What is freedom? – Your good conscience" – said Periander, the seventh sage.

"I could do this or that or something else, anything would be instructive, particularly if it would lead me astray

and cause me distress" – this is how free spirits think and speak, the lovers of knowledge: for this reason they laugh when they are accused of weak will and irrationality.

372. Have I ever felt a pang of conscience? – My memory is completely silent in response to this inquiry.

373. Morality is a proto-scientific method of coming to terms

with the explanation for our affects and states. Morality has

the same resemblance to a future pathology of general feelings"?! that alchemy has to chemistry.

374. There are no moral phenomena at all; but rather only a moral interpretation of certain phenomena (– an erroneous interpretation!))???

375. Criminals are usually no match for their deeds, they recant

and slander them.?"?

376. "Better to lie in bed and feel sick than to have to do something" – all self-tormenters live by this secret principle.

377. Recognizing that I agree with others makes me slightly suspicious of whatever it is we agree upon.

378. The one who knows finds the pia fraus?' even more tasteless than the impia fraus.?"°°

379. Beware the sancta sim plicitas:?" she is the one who always

had the task of building a fire around the stake.??®

3 SUMMER–AUTUMN 1882 85

380. At one time the religious explanation supported the sci-

entific one: and even now the moral explanation supports the physiological one. Those who think very little and have learned

very little trace everything back to morality, their mood swings under the influence of the weather, digestive problems,

anemia, their urinary needs or the equivalent, their lack of success, ennui, dissatisfaction, insecurity.

381. If you wanted to say out loud all the things that you

have

already done in your thoughts, then everyone would scream: "away with this disgusting vermin! It befouls the earth" – and they would have all forgotten that they had also done the

very same thing in their own thoughts. – This is how candor makes us moral.?"?

To speak in physiological terms, the drive of the weak to be assimilated by the strong finds expression in morality.

382. "I love her and that is why I wish she loved – but why me

in particular? I do not love myself enough for that" – this is

how divine love speaks out of the mouth of a man.

So you wish to beguile him? Then pretend to be embarrassed around him.?'®

383. Demanding to be loved in return is vanity and sensuality.

384. People who mistrust themselves want more to be loved than to love, in order, if just for a moment, to be allowed to

believe in themselves.

A god who loves is not worthy of letting himself be loved: he prefers to continue to be hated.

86 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

sion for humans: the latter would cause the very rapid downfall of humankind.

386. A little more compassion among humans, and despair over life would knock at the door.

387. "Love your neighbor" – that means above all: "leave your neighbor alone!" – And precisely this part of virtue is the most difficult!

388. Trivial suffering makes us small, great suffering makes us

great. The will to suffer greatly should therefore be a requirement of selfishness.

ment of selfishness.

390. An enchanting work! Yet how unbearable that its creator constantly reminds us that it is his work. Doesn't he know that

"the father" is always a comical figure?

391. Happiness in frequent, small doses rewards us with misery

in frequent, small doses: and thereby corrupts character.

392. All creature comforts should be used as a sick person uses

a bed: for convalescence.

393. We do not find the embarrassment of very clever people believable.?

394. H(umans) are the animals with red cheeks: all too often they have had to be ashamed of themselves." "I am predestined to see and not to believe, to me all people of faith are something foreign and noisy."

3 SUMMER--AUTUMN 1882 87

395. There is a kind of arrogance in goodness that manifests itself as malice. Our vanity becomes most difficult to wound precisely in those moments when our pride has just been wounded.

396. These two wenches, past and future, are making so much noise that the present is running away from them.

397. To make a "thou shalt" out of an "I feel like," to reshape habit into virtue, customs into ethics: this is a subtle old ancient form of second-rate counterfeiting – and I still see through it today.

398. "Thou shalt" sounds sweeter to most than "I will this": the herd-instinct still lingers in their ears.

399. In a certain state of illness it is impossible to be anything

but miserly. Miserliness is an affect. You love my level-headed-

ness too much: even this miserliness is illness.

400. We become mistrustful not because we find a reason to be so, but rather "we always find a reason" to be mistrustful

when we become mistrustful.

401. Under certain circumstances the overall damage is less when people unleash their affects on others than when they unleash them on themselves: this is especially true of creative

people, whose usefulness extends into the future.

402. We would be in big trouble if people did not have their malicious petty thoughts! How much more pleasure do they have then, how much less pain do they inflict upon us then?"

88 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

404. It is the heart that inspires: and it is the mind that heart-

ens us and keeps us cool when we are in danger. Oh language!

405. What? A great man? I see in him only a dramatizer of

his

own ideals.

Selfishness in the case of thieves, robbers, usurers and speculators is fundamentally unambitious and unassuming enough: certainly there is nothing easier than merely wanting

people's money.

406. Faust, the tragedy of knowledge? Really? Faust makes me laugh,

407. The supremely tragic motifs have up to now remained unused: poets know nothing from experience about the 100 tragedies of conscience.

408. People speak of the causes of affects and mean the occasions for them.

409. He has sacrificed people for the sake of his knowledge and is proudest of nothing so much as this cruelty against himself.

410. In those who know, compassion seems almost laughable, like sensitive skin on a giant.?!"

412. Being compassionate as well as cruel is necessary for being either.

413. More than a few who wanted to exorcise their demons have thereby driven themselves into the swine.?!?

3 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 89

414. "Those who praise" mostly portray themselves as giving something back: in truth they want to be given a gift.?'?

415. Human beings are not revealed in their affects, only their affects are revealed.!?

Our eyes hear more subtly than our ears: we have better understanding and taste when we read than when we hear – with books as with music.

417. Christianity poisoned Eros: while he did not die of it, he

did degenerate into "vice."?!°

Full of passion but heartless and playful: that's how the Greeks were, even Greek philosophers, like Plato.

418. Intimacy is genuine only in heartless people and for them

almost a shameful thing.'

That's how an explosion happens by striking a match.

420. If the goddess of music wanted to speak in words rather than tones, we would cover our ears.

421. Responding to praise with delight is in some people

intellectual vanity, in others a sign of a courteous heart.?!®

422. We lie with our tongues, but we tell the truth with our mouths and faces?! – this is how physiognomists see it.?2°

423. Sensuality hastens the growth of love so that the root stays weak and the whole plant is easily torn out.??!

90 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

424. Some people feel a deep need for their enemies: for them

alone they also feel hatred at first sight.???

425. My eyes see other people's ideals, and I am often trans-

ported by what I see: but you nearsighted people then think these are my ideals!

426. The morality of every society says that isolation is guilt.

428. When we are forced to see people in a new light, there is

a tendency to blame them harshly for the inconvenience they cause.'

429. In kindness there is no trace of hate for people, but for

that very reason all too much contempt for people."

431. Like a tree: the more it wishes to grow upwards into height and light, the more strongly its roots must reach in the

opposite direction: its will goes inwards, downwards, into the

darkness, the depths, outwards – into so-called "evil."?2°

432. You call it God decomposing himself: yet it is only him shedding his skin: – he sheds his moral skin! And you are supposed to see him again soon, beyond good and evil.

433. A people is a detour of nature, on the way to 5, 6 great

men.°27

434. At patriotic festivals even the spectators are among the

performers.??8

3 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1882 91

435. Even the ugly has its ugly little ceremonial robe: it is

called "the sublime."???

436. What is good? – "That which is pretty and moves us at the same time" – answered a little girl.??"

If God is a God of love, then conscience's bite would have to be God's bite and consequently a bite given out of

love.??!

437. Courageous, heedless, mocking and even somewhat violent: that's how wisdom wants us: she is a woman and – only ever loves the warrior.3??

438. Many soldiers and yet so few men! Many uniforms and even more uniformity.???

439. "Once again the time of harvest is past: the wind blows over the empty fields, and now even the most bountiful crop seems to me a monstrous loss" – this is the way every creative person feels.

440. A real man wants two things: danger and play. That is why he desires a woman as the most dangerous plaything.??*

441. The responsibility of a woman is to discover and preserve the child in a man.?

442. To want the emancipation of women achieves only the emasculation of men.

443. Man should be trained for war and woman to help the warrior's recovery: anything else is foolishness.?3°
mind but – unfortunately – also to those who darn its socks 237338

92 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

There is no more pitiful group than scholars: with the exception of those few who have been scarred by war in body and mind.

There are too few men: and that is why women are becoming manly.???

445. What a subtlety it is that God learned Greek when he wanted to become a writer; just as subtle, that he did not learn it better!?*0

This thinker is colder than ice; for that reason he burns the fingers of those who touch him and is easily regarded as red hot.34!

3 (2) Pine and Lightning.

High above human and beast I grew;
And I speak – No one speaks with me.

xx

Too alone I grew and too high:
I wait: but what I am waiting for, anyway?

xk

Too near to me is the throne of clouds, –
I wait for the first lightning bolt.??%

xk

3 B"

Portofino

Here I sit waiting – waiting? Yet for nothing,
Beyond good and evil, and lusting no more
For the light than for the darkness,
Friend of noon and friend of eternity.

xk

3 SUMMER–AUTUMN 1882

3 (4)? On the High Seas.

Friend – spoke Columbus – do not trust
a Genoese ever again!
He's always staring into the blue,
What is most distant draws him all too much!

ok

Whomever he loves, he likes to lure
Far beyond space and time – –
Stars beyond stars shine above us,
Eternity roars all around us."

93

[4=N V 9c. N VI 1b. N V 8.

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4 1]

We are about to encounter the greatest excitation – and behind

it, the backlash! the yearning toward nothingness! – And we do

not want to perish, either in this excitation or in this yearning

– we friends of life.

4 bl

I have the most extensive soul of all Europeans now living or

who ever lived: Plato Voltaire – – – it depends on conditions that do not entirely depend on me, but rather on the "essence of things" – I could become the European Buddha: which admittedly would be a counterpart of the Indian one.

4 [3]!

In all first encounters there is luck and some kind of good omen.

4 [4]?

A false saying goes as follows: "those who do not redeem themselves, how can they redeem others?" If I have the key to

your shackles, why would your lock and mine have to be the same?

In war you are holy and even when you murder and burn.

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“Uni-form” is what they call it, the thing they wear: uni-
for-

mity is what they cover with it.⁴

You should go back to sleep – and dream better.

This cruelty sits in my guts. See, I am evil.

You say: it is the cause that justifies the war? The war is
what

justifies the cause!®

Herds are no good, not even when they follow you.

The shepherd is a gilded tool of the herd.

4 [5]

Reason is the exception even in the wisest person: chaos and
necessity and whirling of the stars – this is the rule.

We must make our death into a festival and thereby be a
little malicious toward life: a woman who wants to leave us,
us!

As for heroes, I do not have that high an opinion of them:
but still: it is the most acceptable form of existence,
namely,

when there is no other choice.

4 [6]?

We both have something for each other: you the affects I
the reasons.

I make balsam for my wounds from my own vitriol.

I milk your udder, beloved misery!

Many god-humans? have existed on earth: and all god-humans
created their god.

There is no greater enmity on earth than between god-humans
and their gods.

96 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

You brothers, I have exposed myself: I am not ashamed to
show myself naked.

Shame is the ghoul who became a companion of humans
when they were seized with the desire to transcend animals.
People are free to believe in Zarathustra: what does Zarat-
hustra care?

4 [7] Demigod. Hero. Man. Child.

Am I not after all a comrade of companion-animals.

4 8]

I come to help you – and you complain that I don’t want
to weep with you.’®

4 [9]

I have known this for a long time: people like my m(other)
and s(ister) must be my natural enemies – nothing can be
done about this: the reason lies in the essence of all

things.

Being with p(eople) like them poisons the air for me, and I require a lot of self-overcoming.!!

4 [10]

To men. This is the doctrine of holiness.

To women. Beyond good and evil.

To children. Noon and eternity.

Zarathustra among animals. The seven solitudes.

4 [11]

Any single one of my affects would have brought about my downfall. I have always played one off against the other.

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4 [12]

There should not be any people who instill disgust or hatred in me.

4 [13]!

"Like Brahma, men live alone; like gods, they live in twos; like a village, they live in threes; where there are more, there is

bustle!3 and turmoil."!4

Do not speak as a human does to animals, you say, – – –

My strongest trait is self-overcoming. But I also have the greatest need for it – I am always on the edge of the abyss.!°

I am speaking and a child is playing: is it possible to be more serious than we both are right now?!

4 [14]

I am not great enough not to have these feelings: but I am great enough not to be ashamed of them.!"

4 [ss]

There is no one alive who would be worthy of praising me.

For man "I will this" for woman "I must"

I belong to the race of berserkers, of libertines, of those obsessed with revenge, of religious fanatics – I myself almost forgot it.

4 [16]

Morality has been taken to its pinnacle by freethinking and it has been overcome.

I am addressing men, spoke Zarathustra – tell the women to go away."

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4 i)"

A fool spoke in this way: make the old sacrifices to a new spirit, transform the old soul by means of a new body.

Blood justifies nothing; blood also redeems nothing. I dis-

like those love me(a}ls,?? – – –

4 [18] *

The best man is evil, the best woman is bad.

It was the love of shepherd and herd that from this time on
conceived benefit as good and holy:

It was the love of children and race: this love was rage
against the betrayers of the love of all, and guilt was a
betrayal

of the love of all.

They conceived good and evil out of love: and not out of
prudence, for love is older than prudence.

What universal love demanded was once useful: and whoever
felt the strongest love was made by the herd into its shep-
herd.

Loving thy neighbor was still insignificant, the I despised:
and the herd was above all else.

4 [19]

I honor all h(umans) I despise only the Pharisees.

4 [20]"

One morning Zarathustra climbed up a mountain: when he
was alone with himself he glorified himself in this way:
you,

my book, – – –

Humankind has no goal: it can even set a goal for itself –
not for the end, not for preserving the species, but rather
for

abolishing it.

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And the people should all speak: this criminal is holy.

The creator (the one who knows), the communicator (the
artist), the simplifier (the lover).

Bear my virtue! (as a superpower).

State and society are not necessary for some: but they must
endure them and withdraw as much as possible.

Austerity of the one who cannot love.

4 [21] An uncanny and inglorious goal.

4 [22] %

(One day Zarathustra glorified himself and spoke in this
way)

They must combine three characteristics: to be authentic, to
want and to be able to make themselves understood, and to be
privy to knowledge (into one)

the disciples of sacred selfishness

or one of the three

or to be able to be merely a tool?" of the three.

he should say: I am evil, I preserve the force of evil.

All people should turn their existence into the goal of the plan.

Up to now there has been no goal: onward, so let's seize one for ourselves.

Speaking on behalf: of vain people, of cruel people, etc.

IO UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

The supreme pleasure: that which we must do, even that which we want. In this way to integrate ourselves into the grand plan.

4 [23] All creation is communication.

The one who knows the one who creates the one who loves are one.

4 [24]

1000 formulas for the recurrence (is the threat).

4 [25] The birth of the superhumans."®

4 [26]

Good people as the necessary Pharisees.

Here, too, there is a contrast like the one between religious

people and people of faith.

Those who create what is good find their opposite in those who preserve what is good.

The point where people find the courage to perceive their evil as their good e.g., Christians their "cowardice."

4 [27]°*°

Good people now almost worthless.

It all depends on evil people with religious intentions! And it

has always been that way!

4 [28]?

I have to be an angel if I want to live: you do not have such

hard conditions.

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4 [29]?

At the same time, let your enlightenment also be a dawn.

Error in crime.

it is not pleasant feelings that are called good – but rather

states of fullness of power

She was aroused by what they once revered.

you must newly redefine your need: that which already is should be a necessity for you.

4 [30]

Anyone who lives at the foot of the highest Alps does not see their peaks: excuse me – – –

4 [31]

We are also punished for our virtues.??

4 [32]

They call it a love meal when their redeemer is devoured out of love.

Churches are founded on blood and reason-shunning.

4 [33]

But what are you not saying about the faithful of the correct

faith? What does your silence mean? – Zarathustra smiled and said only the words “All honor to the vanquished!”

4 [34]

If compassion does not have to break through a hard shell

– –

I presuppose compassion: to be cruel is a disease of the brain

and of the nerves.

102 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

We can only be silent when we have bows and arrows: otherwise we babble and – bicker.

I would like to remove from the world its heartbreaking character

4 [35]

It is not the finger of God that is crushing your windpipe. Long ago, they say, God did approach the dying: then he became anguished and horrified.

4 [36]°°

Actors have little intellectual conscience: they believe in whatever lets them instill the strongest belief.

Only the appraisers and the inventors of new values are creative:3’ the world revolves around them alone. Anyone who instills belief in new values is known among the people as “creative” –

4 [37]°8

Anyone who sees the base qualities in a person also usually feels a certain attraction for these qualities and triggers their release.

As one who creates, you run away from yourself – you cease being your contemporary.

Disgust at filth can be so great that it prevents us from cleaning ourselves.

Fools want to have it better than good.

4 [38]?

What must I do to become blessed? Be blessed*? and do what you must do.

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Something becomes dear to us: and no sooner do we love it with all our hearts, than the tyrant, the higher self, speaks to

us: "give me that very thing as a sacrifice!" – and we give it to

him.

I urge you to battle, not to work – I urge you to victory, not to peace. May your work be a battle, your peace a victory.

I awoke you from your sleep, for a nightmare oppressed you. And now you say: "what should we do now! Night is all around us." – you ungrateful ones!#!

Everything about women is a riddle – everything about women has one solution: pregnancy.*?

If you want to have an easy life, then always stay with the herd. Lose yourself in the herd! Love the shepherd and honor the fangs of his dog!

If you know how to bark and bite, then – be the herd's dog: then you will make life easy for yourself.

I know everything that is good and everything that is evil:

I

also know what is beyond good and evil.

Good and evil are God's prejudices – said the serpent. But even the serpent was one of God's prejudices.

The Church is the stone on the grave of a God-made-human: it does not want him to be resurrected.

I love myself as I love my God: who could forgive me a sin?

I know only sins against my God: yet who knows my God? –

104 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

4 [39]® Noon and Eternity. Thus spoke Zarathustra. 4 [40]

What keeps me alive? Pregnancy: and every time a work was born, life hung by a thin thread.

I have hidden myself away. I want to keep my disgust from them, these puny people. This has become most difficult for me: but they are blameless, like grass and weeds.

We are only ever pregnant with our own child.®

You say "this is dark." I placed a cloud in front of your sun.

But look how the edges of the cloud are shining and becoming bright!

Don't look at the sun! The moon is still too bright for your nocturnal eye!

You should love peace as a means to a new war!

In war, revenge is silent; in war, what is person(al) dies.

4 [41]*°

Lies and dissimulation – how all education works.

How should I make fun in a terrible way?

"You have overcome me" See to it that I become wings for you and not a stumbling block!

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4 [42]"

There once was an ancient*® righteous god; he had substance and also a heart: and much anger and love were in his vitals.

And behold, love played a trick on him and he fell in love with humans: so that this love became hell for him.

What did this ancient righteous god do? He convinced a human woman to bear him a son: and this son of God gave humans only this advice: "love God! as I love him! What do we sons of God care about good and just people!"

And like a jealous lover the ancient righteous god persecuted humans with his love."

Do you think he succeeded? In time, he convinced precisely those among humans he did not like, good and just people. They called themselves "Church" and the chosen: and babbled a lot about their love for God – love-deprived people! Then they broke the ancient righteous god's heart: and he suffered the same fate as his son: he died on the cross of com-

passion. In truth these good and just people are corrupters of

the zest for life and not just of the ancient righteous gods.

"Three things should always accompany us – they were always saying – truth, money and virtue: this is how we love God."

"We are chosen and the most superterrestrial ones on earth."

4 [43]!

Whatever we most love to do, we would like this to be regarded

as the thing we find most difficult to do: and be regarded as such

by ourselves.

Our sacrifices prove only how little every thing means to us when we love something."

Moral states and strivings are only means to knowledge, immoral

ones as well.

106 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

The pleasure in knowing is an extremely intensive faith. If we do not achieve this, then there is still a wanting-to-know

in
response to stimuli, e.g., as desire for security or novelty
or
desire for something worth desiring, yet to be discovered.
Since the ones who know spoke only of knowledge, this in-
volves
much mendacity – they had an interest in letting knowledge
appear to be the most valuable state.
Lovers of knowledge! And you have never even killed a human
being in order to see how it feels!
The perfect knowledge of necessity would abolish' every
"should" – but to understand even the necessity of "shoulds"
as a consequence of ignorance.

4 [44]"

As happy as an elephant when it tries to stand on its
head.*°

You lack the courage to burn yourself up and to perish: and
you will never become something new in this way. That which
today gives us wings color fashion and force will be ashes
tomorrow.

Marriage might be right for those incapable of either love
or

friendship – for almost everyone then – and perhaps even
for those very rare people who are capable of both at the
same

4 [45]

There is another kind of virtue, a mercenary one, and it
wants to be paid well, either here or in a not-here-place
and it
calls this "justice."

Oh you friends of gift-giving virtue, let us dance in mock-
ery of all mercenary virtue.

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But you have not yet learned this from me: how to dance in
mockery.

4 [46]

That which is to us warmth or light or noise or array of
stars

– may seem somewhat different to senses other than human
ones: yet it will never be goodness or wisdom or love.
Loving thy neighbor. When utility is the driving force.'

4 [47]

all around you is a meaning that makes things degenerate,
and "distress" is absent in everything"

4 [48] Community (not herd) his overcomings tablet difficult
That my animals without [-] willingly [-] escort® to me.

4 [49]°

The interpretations 1) Error of the first cause, a god conceived as opposite (— — —

Your life is wasted: you are like a sycophant.
where your poverty and sobriety cried out to heaven
let a lightning bolt lick you with its tongue!
they shot an arrow of flaming love into the universe.
It is not the ignorance of people that is pitiful: what is pitiful is the people themselves!

108 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Science only as a kind of asceticism.
exploitation of the accidental — ambiguity as the condition for life in many species — consequently indifference to essence

How is it possible that you narrow souls can keep up with my thinking?

4 [50]

Don't get incensed! They are taking your money away from you! and there are more important things that poorer people also have access to. Jesus as nonmonetary sacrifice!

62 4 [s]

Asceticism of the intellect as preparation for creating. Intentional deprivation of the creative drives.

4 [52]

There are preachers: they teach suffering. They serve you, even if they hate you at the same time.

I do not address you as I would address the people. For them, the best thing is to despise and destroy themselves: the

next best thing is to despise and destroy each other.

4 [53]

Every effect is followed by an effect — this belief in causality

is anchored in the strongest of the instincts, the instinct for revenge.

Let's not confuse these things: the downfall of an actor is not being praised, the downfall of a genuine person is not being loved.

The antithesis of an actor is not an honest person, but rather

a secretive self-deceiving person.

(most actors belong to this group)

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4 [54]

"Evil has its heroes just as good has its heroes" – in the mouth of a La Rochefoucauld this is complete naivete. Seeing and still not believing is the cardinal virtue of the one who knows.

In striving not to know themselves ordinary people are very subtle and devious.

In G(ermany) aspiration is admired much more than ability: it is the right place for unaccomplished and pretentious people.

4 [55]

The sight of naive people is a delight, as long as they are evil

by nature and have an intellect.

Sly people are usually simple and not complicated people.

Labyrinth.

Labyrinthine people never seek the truth, but rather always only their Ariadne – whatever they might say to us.

4 [56]°°

When we feel comfortable around p(eople), we like ascribing this comfort to their and our morality.

Skepticism regarding all moral values is a symptom of the emergence of a new moral code of values.

When we no longer feel ashamed even about our own evil, this is a step forward in intellectual taste.

To have no phrase at the ready that would corrupt his philosophy –

IIIO UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Contempt for what I do, and contempt for what I am.

The Church is nothing but a profoundly mendacious kind of st(at)e.

The masculine animal is cruel to what it loves – not out of malice, but because when it is in love it feels itself too strongly

and no longer has any feelings at all left over for the feelings of

others.

4 [s]"

Those who are lacking in love are stingy even with their courtesy.

In matters of honor, women are coarse and clumsy.

If we want to have friends, we must be willing to go to war for them, i.e., we must be able to be an enemy.

Today they had the good intention of being friendly: but

how miserable they were at it, what little inventiveness!
I divide philosophical people into two categories: those always pondering their own defense and those pondering attacks against their enemies.

The hero is cheerful – this displeases writers of tragedies. With sarcastic people, feelings seldom spill forth, but always very loudly.

It is astounding to what foolishness even sensuality can be led when corrupted by love, how as soon as love speaks to it, sensuality loses all good taste and calls what is ugly beautiful.

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4 [58]

So-called lovable people know how to spend the small change of love on us.

All those who have not yet forgotten how to digest their experiences have also not yet forgotten the slothfulness of digestion: they become indignant about it, in this time of haste

and stress.°®

For women there is only one single point of honor; they have to believe that they love more than they are loved. Just

beyond this point lies prostitution.

Cruelty toward the man she does not love.

Will to self, selfishness is a subtle and a later evolved refinement-

ment of the will to pleasure: insofar as that will to pleasure is a self.

"You" is older than "I" and yet still survives in the J.

"T? – this is a working hypothesis for the purpose of making the world conceivable – just like matter and atom.

4 [59]?

As soon as prudence says, "don't do that, it will turn out badly for you" – I have always disobeyed it.

A bad reputation

The utile is always just a means, its end in any case is the dulce"? Utilitarians are stupid.

They do not love me: is this a reason not to bless them?

Behold! The world has just now become perfect.

II UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

4 [60]

sit tibi terra levis"? to wish people in Germany well it is

nec-

essary to wish that they might find the earth rather heavy.

4 [61]

Basic tenet

It could not be tolerated: therefore the following things that

make life easier are required.

Away with good and evil!

Highest degree of self-satisfaction!

Tragic people step back!

Avoiding the strong affects!

The liberation of multifaceted people.

Do not act differently, but rather think differently of your self!

The vanity of sublime people!

against the cruelty of the heroic.

all these life improvements are useless because our value

judg-

ments have not changed, e.g., health.

against "all-too-hasty" people.

4 [62>

Petty thieves, petty backbiters, petty cynics and detractors

should be wiped out – not murderers

there should be no compassion for mosquitoes"? and fleas

Contemptible and terrible people.

The forests should be preserved, evil people should be preserved.

4 [63]

Do people who know have ownership? Truly, I forgot it – or did I unlearn it?

4 4 [64]7

Our evil affects also have a conscience and become annoyed when they have let themselves be overcome.

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Conscience is a ventriloquist, when it speaks, we cease to believe that its voice comes from us.

Religion wants to make people happy and to put "I must" in place of "thou shalt": it wants to free us from what is impossible

for humans in morality.

Now I am just – means in many cases "now I am avenged.""°

The filthiest thing about "good people" is how they interpret their inclinations and disinclinations as their duty.

The pride of the unhappy lover tells him that his beloved does not deserve to be loved by him at all. But a superior pride

says to him: "No one deserves to be loved. – You just do not love her enough!"

4 [65]

The unhappiness of the unhappy lover does not end when love is returned, but rather when love is increased."

If we want to be rid of people then we only need to diminish ourselves in their eyes – this touches their vanity immediately and they run away.

As long as you remain on hostile terms, your time together is not yet at an end – she should not be allowed to see you at

all, that is how superior and distant you should be toward her.

4 [66]

The less he is accepted, the more Zarathustra keeps giving. "I was stingy – you were right to disparage me!"

Sequence of themes to be arranged according to their philanthropy. he is being exiled.

114 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

4 [67]

Conquering our affects means in most cases temporarily inhibiting and damming them up: thus increasing the danger. Most people who rescue some unfortunate person from danger were driven not by compassion but by courage and danger.

Recklessness has done more great deeds than loving thy neighbor.

Humans are only now making the world conceivable to themselves – and we are still in the process of doing so – : and once they have understood it, and they feel that it is completely their work – alas, and now they must Zove their work,

like every creator!"

Men, as long as there are men, will be trained for war and hunting: that is why they now love knowledge as the most extensive opportunity for war and hunting. What a woman could ever love about knowledge would have to be something else – – –

4 [68]

We take the bitterness that we feel toward people and use it to justify our moral outrage – and we admire ourselves in the

process: and the fading of our hatred to justify our forgiveness

– and we admire ourselves once again.’®

If we have enough of the truth, we no longer need lies to interact with people: with these lies we can deceive and lead

others astray any way we like.

4 [69]

The highest form of courage in those who know is not revealed when they provoke wonder and horror – but rather

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when they have to be perceived by those who do not know as superficial, lowly, cowardly, irrelevant.

Those who know must also understand how to place the crown of victory on their own heads: they cannot wait because

it is this that drives them to new transformations.

4 [70]

The passion of two people for one another – this is in all circumstances two passions, and with different arcs peaks speeds: their lines can cross, nothing else.

We say pleasure and think of lusts, we say sense and think of sensuality, we say body and think of underbellies – and in

this way we deprive three good things of their dignity.

Bourgeois and courtly virtues do not understand each other and malign each other.

Even our ability to learn and our industriousness have to do with talent.

That everyone is permitted to learn to read and reads, this will eventually ruin not only writers but even minds in general.

4 [71]

He wronged me – this is bad. But that he wants to go so far as to beg my pardon, this drives me crazy!®!

It requires very good character not to attribute the unpleasant

consequences of some trivial folly to our character.

To actually attribute the unpleasant consequences of our own folly to folly and not to our character: this requires more

character than most people have.

116 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

No sooner do we progress even one step beyond average hu(man) goodness, than our actions are reprimanded.

You say, “I like this” and think you are praising me! – Oh you fools, how I like this!

Scientific people share the fate of rope-makers: they weave

their strand longer, but in the process they themselves move – backwards.

82 4 [72]

Life is hard to bear: it requires defiance in the morning and

surrender in the afternoon

I am absent-minded: I don't have any appetite until after a meal.*?

Truly, the refutability of a theory is not the least of its charms.*4

Constitutional monarchs were thought to be virtuous – they can no longer “commit injustice” – but in return they were stripped of their power. Since then they have wanted nothing but war – why is that?

Those fortunate enough to remain obscure should also take advantage of the freedom that darkness affords and especially “whisper well.”®°

4 [73]

I hate honorable men?” far more than sinners!

Do I love music? I don't know – too often I also find myself hating it. Yet music loves me – and as soon as someone leaves me, music jumps into my lap and wants to be loved.

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How long until fame arrives?®®

One moment he squares his shoulders as if the whole weight of the world were to be laid upon us – and the next moment he trembles like a rosebud that is weighed down by a mere dew

drop. My brothers and sisters, do not act so gently toward me!

we are all comely sturdy male and female donkeys, and we are certainly no trembling rosebuds.

4 [74]

In order to need brakes,” it is first necessary to have wheels.

I have lived close to death for too long to have any fear of life. I call such p(eople) “totalities”

4 [75]

I call them actors (those who communicate)

Out of overflowing life, superhumans have an opium smoker's hallucinations and madness and Dionysian dance: they do not suffer from the pains that follow.

Illness now leads to much that is not in itself a symptom of illness: to a vision.

Not your sin – your sobriety cries to heaven?!

Save us from sin and give us back our arrogance!

The pale criminal in a dungeon and by contrast Prometheus!
Degeneration!

"We want to create a being" we all want to have a part in
it,

to love it, we all want to be pregnant – and therefore to
honor

and respect ourselves.

118 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

We must have a goal that makes us all love one another! All
other goals deserve to be annihilated!"?

4 [76]"

To have understood a philos(opher) and to be convinced by
him.

Today I turn everything into gold, give me what you will
– destiny!

Don't let yourselves be deceived! The most active peoples
are now the most fatigued! They no longer have the strength
to be lazy!

The only happiness lies in creating: you all should join me
in

creating and in every action you will have this happiness!

You should preserve chaos within you: those who are yet to
come want to form themselves from it!

Redemption from the eternal flux.

4 [77]

We often perform our actions as an opiate against the past.

To do our favorite thing without describing it in lofty
phrases

– can be heroism. To be ashamed of sublime gestures.

"I follow" – not "I will this."

"I couldn't spare anything when I created superhumans. All
of your evils and falsehoods, your lies and your ignorance –
everything is in their semen."

(Contra strict vegetarianism) Do we really want to create
lamb-souls and visionary virgins? Lions are what we want and
monsters of force and love.

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Let humans be the impetus for something that is no longer
human.

Not to become unworldly – but rather to overpower the
world and ourselves within it.

I want to turn procreation and death into a festival.

4 [78]

We must be as good at being cruel as we are at being com-
passionate: let us guard against becoming smaller than
nature!

I teach not only compassion but also cruelty: however, I
also
teach that intellect is part of both, and a goal.
We must prepare the earth for the superhumans and animals
and plants
I inoculate you with the madness
Your excess love is there for the puny people.
You see her on stage, but you must see her in life and not
in
any way slight her.

Your best things amount to nothing without a performance.
Moral people feel smug about their pangs of conscience.

4 [79]

You are waging war? You fear one of your neighbors? So
remove the border markers – then you will have no more
neighbors.”

4 [80] To begin with funeral rites.

120 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

I foresee something terrible. Imminent chaos, everything in
flux.

1. Nothing that has value in itself – nothing that com-
mands “thou shalt.”

2. It is intolerable – we must counter the spectacle of this
annihilation by creating.

3. We must counter these shifting goals with a single goal
– create it.

4. As material we have everything that has been incorpo-
rated, in this we are not free. 70 grasp this material, to com-
pre-
hend it (through science).

5. To create superhumans after we have thought about all of
nature in relation to ourselves, made it conceivable.”

6. We can only love something that is wholly related to us:
we have the most love for a being we have conceived. When it
comes to a work and a child, love doesn’t need to be com-
manded. Advantage of superhumans.

4 [81]

I do not want life again. How have I endured it? Creating.
What makes me endure the sight of it? a glance at the super-
humans who affirm life. I have tried to affirm it myself –
Alas!

4 [82]*8

Thinking of life should be the focus of recuperation: other-
wise thinking only of responsibilities.

Mémoires.

I grasped primum vivere, '® with vivere!

to know in order to live – earlier: in order to deny life.
° and everything that has to do

4 [83]

The dissolution of morality has as its practical consequence the atomistic individual and eventually the fragmentation of the individual into pluralities – absolute flux.

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This is why, now more than ever, one goal is needed and love, a new love.'®! 4 [84]'°?

There is a danger of turning back into animality. We create a posthumous justice for all of the dead and give their lives a

meaning when we shape superhumans out of this material and give all of the past a goal.

If I did not love humans, how could I stand Zarathustra?

Honor actors for my sake and seek the best ones offstage!

Whip.

4 [85]

When Zarathustra had said this, a mom!" waved to him and spoke: "Now I gladly want to die, for my mouth has nothing more to teach Zarathustra."

Do not fear the flux of things: this flux turns back into it-

self: it flees itself not just twice.!°*

All "it was" becomes an "it is" again. The past bites all that

is future in the tail.

Where "should" is no longer felt, –

Emergence of love – love as consequence of morality.

4 [86]

I still have all these wild dogs at (my place), but in my cellar.

I do not want to ever hear them bark.!

Then a mom waved to him and said: Now I die in peace I have experienced Zarathustra.

122 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

4 [87]

No one comes to see me. And I myself – I went to see everyone and found no one.!"

4 [88]!07

On the penultimate day Zarathustra sent home the disciples who had accompanied him and spoke thus to them:

The location Zarathustra laughed at, must [– –]

Everything has 2 faces: one of passing away, one of becoming.

The more there is to the individual, the more the herd to

which it belongs will advance. The bon gont'8
of morality.
of knowledge reaches up to the highest level
If you had any idea of the agony of responsibility that superior
humans feel!

4 [89]

On the Morality of Superior Humans.
Everything that is otherwise moral has become love here.'
Yet now a new "thou shalt" begins – the knowledge of the
free spirit – the inquiry into the supreme goals.

4 [go]

Just as we no longer need morality, so – we no longer need
religion either. The "I love God" – the single ancient form
of
the religious – is converted into the love of an ideal – has
become creative – nothing but God-humans.
Morality is needed: by what standards are we to act, since
we still must act? And we must evaluate what we have done
– by what standards?

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Finding errors in its genesis is no argument against morality.
Morality is a condition of life. "Thou shalt"

On the sanctification of the passions.

He obeys as much as he can.

I have lived on the narrowest stoop of life.

Suffering such as mine is the suffering of someone who is
buried.

Every superior act is a many-sided violation of ethical law.
To teach utility and reason!!!! We are not nearly reasonable
enough. for that. 4 [91]?

To acknowledge the value of all passions one by one, but to
sanctify them.

I wanted to know, now I am struck by my fate (vivisection)
and my pain at the silent stare of the dog.

The ones who create should be treated humanely, they are
lacking in loving thy neighbor.'

Someone profound.!!4 – You forgive today what was done
to you. But you have not yet experienced it at all: after
half a

year you will never again forgive and forget it.

4 [92]!

No sooner does the intellect collide with morality than all
hell breaks loose.

H(umans) began by taking morality for themselves, we,
too, can give ourselves a morality!

124 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

"What is most difficult?"

I did all this, spoke Zarathustra, and today I offer it cheaply

– for a girl's smile.

And have you nothing more to say to human beings?

No, said Zarathustra, the cup is empty. And when he ha(d) said this, he went on his way and alone. Yet his disciples wept.!!6

Beware of hurting a hermit. A hermit is like a deep well: it is easy to toss a stone into it, but how do you propose to retrieve it? A hermit never forgives.!!

sticking yet another arrow of contempt into his quiver. plucking

4 [93]"8

Don't reveal yourself! And if you must, then in rage but not in shame!

Do I have to tell you how to defend yourselves against burglars and cutthroats? I speak to those who are tired of their

virtues and enjoy being robbed and maligned just once so that

they can make a festival out of their virtue. –

4 [94]"'

Do not forget this about me! I told h(umans) to create superhumans, I taught noon and eternity and redemption from flux, and my doctrine is: the For All is older and was called good sooner than the "for me"; the "for me" must still

be sanctified by you.

You should not kill your senses but rather sanctify them – make them innocent.

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Then all the people said: we must destroy the destroyer of morality –

If we want to become perfect as human beings, we must also become perfect as animals.

You will always have only as much morality as your strength allows.

Superhumans, solitary wanderers, timid ones – –

4 [95]

a disciple – this is neither a child nor a creative work," here

Zarathustra was silent and, transformed, stared intensely into

space. His disciples approached him anyway and as(ked) him:

"do you have nothing more to share with us – that we can take home with us?"

Zarathustra went onwards until he came to his cave and mountains: there he also found his eagle and his serpent.

Yet

when (he) had greeted the cave and the animals, all at once he

became very old.

At the time it was said among the people: the worst thing is not falling into Zarathustra's hands but dreaming of him at night.!?

He reflected for a long time and said no word while his animals waited before him and the morning strolled through the mountains. Suddenly his eyes took on a different look. It was

around the hour of noon as he groped about and said: – – –
4 [96]!

Injustice should be taken on by someone who (is) capable of it.

Dangers of the solitary person.

Pine

I did all that and I will bear it – Smile of a child

126 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

4 [97]

Here wafts the spirit of a hero – pass by quietly. He suffered too much; for that very reason he is still determined to

inflict suffering.

4 [98]

May he himself have mercy on his soul.

4 [99]

I demand of you every act of self-sacrifice, of goodness, of sacred selfishness, and you should say in response to all that:

"think nothing of it! It suits my taste and no one else's!"

And I

demand in addition that you pursue knowledge because I know it goes against your taste, so that you say: "we probably

have to be this way," but this compulsion of ours should not be

a law nor become a shadow and an irritation to others.

4 [100]

My brothers, I know of no greater consolation for a woman than to tell her: "you, too, can give birth to superhumans."!??

What do you have in common with wolves and cats? who
just keep taking and don't give and who prefer to steal
rather
than take?

You are the ones who keep giving gifts.'??

4 [or]

All of your weaknesses and vices are still following you
within your knowing! A book is difficult to read: but anyone
who has eyes to see – – –

4 [102]

It is your fate to be mistreated: no one fears your revenge.
At least you will not be completely eclipsed in time.!?*

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4 [103]

Compassion in regard to superhumans (Disciples – Chap(ter)).
(Chap(ter)) if I could see superhumans! they do not see me,
they see their vision.

(Chap(ter)) The good – no God gave it to you, and none
will lead you into a better beyond; this cannot be proven;
and

is idle error. Therefore only: "I will this!"

To describe the love for a contemporary (for a genius) –
what torment! but when we place the genius at a distance and
then see the distorted image! (Chap(ter))

4 [104]!

You say you believe in Zarathustra. But what does Zarathus-
tra care? You are my brothers: I do not love you that much:
a

brother, this is neither a child nor a creative work.

I love freethinkers when their hearts are free as well. To
me the

head is like the entrails of the heart. Whatever a heart ac-
cepts,

this must be digested by the head and turned into
thoughts.!?°

Still better for you to rage than to shame!

And when you are cursed, I don't like it that you then want
to bless: it is better to join in the cursing for a bit. May
the

devil take me!!?"

I recommend that all martyrs consider whether the obses-
sion with revenge has driven them to extremes.

4 [105]

your poets books actors are supposed to anesthetize you
against your lack of visions – they impoverish you even
more!

They are not my visions! And poets are supposed to lie!

128 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

I want to have nothing to do with art – except for that which brings joy! Out of pleasure and super-pleasure! The lie

in art is the evil that comes from arrogance!

I don't want to hear your screaming! Yes, now you are "true"!

Overthrow!

4 [106]

This is a counterargument, and I am grateful to you. But now, friend, refute the counterargument for me!

I am delighted to see you, spoke Zarathustra, and yet you are (not) what delights me, rather for me you are a – – –

This is the hour of summer, an hour and no more. To me you are a mountain range: solid as ice, many storms and clouds. . .

4 [107]

I do not want to be hating and loving with them: I cannot bear their cries and their happiness.

4 [108]

N.B. To be accomplished with supreme passion: lovers (deceived) are foolish and they are not able to communicate their love.

Those who know are without love and uncommunicative.

Actors are without love and foolish.

4 [109]

they do not understand me – but it is eerie that they run to my favorite spot.

to turn to the courts is already a sign of contempt.

4 [110]!78

We are proud to worship when we cannot be idols.

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when a w(oman) goes into heat and she pictures m(en) – Look at that pale woman; I would rather fall into her hands, although she has murderous hands, than into her dreams.!"?

Whom does Zarathustra first encounter? He is happy to tolerate them again.

(Chap(ter)) I went into solitude because I wanted to love the

human being, but I could only ever hate them. Finally, I came

to love the superhuman being – since then I have tolerated humans. I want to bring them a new hope! And a new fear – said Zarathustra.

4 [111]

There was a time when I was overcome with disgust at myself; summer 1876. The danger of insanity, a scholar's bad conscience about the interference of metaphysics, the feeling of exaggeration, the ridiculousness of "sitting in judgment" – therefore to restore reason, and, with the greatest austerity, to try to live without metaphysical assumptions. "Freethinking"!°

– above and beyond myself!

4 [1r]'?!°

when I was young

Today I will gladly give all of this up – in return for the smile of a child. You must overcome your youth, too, if you want to be a child again.

Am I truly the one you honor? And if I am – be careful that a falling pillar does not kill you.

4 [113]

Now murderers appear to be sick: this shows how much moral judgments have been incorporated.
to collect captivating things.

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4 [114]

Hard-heartedness is a virtue in compassionate people.!?°

4 [115]

Blood is a bad witness for a truth: blood poisons a doctrine so that it becomes hatred.!*4

4 [116]!

When I was young, I was inclined to inflict pain on myself: people called it my inclination to the sublime.

To nurture ourselves with the grass and acorns of knowledge.

Humans should be the midpoint between plants and ghosts.

I love all these heavy drops, how they fall one by one from the dark cloud that conceals lightning within itself: the name

for this lightning is the superhumans.

4 [u]'?°

The child within us should overpower even the lion within us – spoke Zarathustra.

I do not give alms – I am not poor enough for that – says Zarathustra.

I am a support and a balustrade along a mighty river – grab onto me whoever can! I am not a crutch

to humiliate ourselves and to injure our arrogance: to con-

fess our folly in order to mock our wisdom.

I forbid you to believe in these metaphysical things: here mistrust is appropriate and insight into where the valuation of

these questions came from in earlier times. Our mode of thought must be thoroughly human!

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4 [118]'?7 Moldenhauer!?8 Mainländer!??

4 [119]

but since you want to listen to me, then take from what is mine everything that belongs to you.

4 [120]

The hermit gritting his teeth – he opened his mouth reluctantly.!*°

How is it possible to communicate? How is it possible to be heard? When shall I emerge from my cave into the open? I am the most hidden of all hidden ones.

4 [121]

Look away! Lift yourselves into a higher light! No compassionate person loves superhumans!

4 [122] Here I sat waiting –

Beyond good and evil, enjoying the light

Then enjoying the shadows: nothing but play

Entirely ocean, entirely noon, entirely time without goal.!

*!

4 [123]

Alas for our goodness! – we honor our ancestors.

4 [124]

Your themes always resound with something like despair.

H(einrich) K(öselitz)

4 [125]

Chap(ter): on the rejection of martyrdom.

132 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

4 [126]

A human a group of atoms completely dependent in all its movements on all distributions and alterations of force in the

universe – and on the other hand, like every atom, unpredictable, a something in-and-for-itself.!??

We become conscious of ourselves only as a heap of affects. and even sense perceptions and thoughts belong among these revelations of the affects.

4 [127]

The most tragic of all stories with a heavenly resolution. Zarathustra growing progressively greater – his teaching progressively unfolding along with this increasing great-

ness.

The "return" shining above the last catastrophe like a set-
} 8 P

ting sun.

4 [128]!

helpless, lacking the intellect to help free themselves from
their sins – their condition remains "fixed"

When we suffer a lot, we become humble enough to be
vain.

"I do not know of any reason against it" – but this "I do
not know" is unfortunately not a reason for it! There is so
much I do not know –

4 [129]

When we praise, we always praise ourselves: when we
blame, we always blame others.

I am lying down below, shrouded in heavy melancholy –
my life hangs on small coincidences.

(Chap(ter)) Keep your souls fresh cool (against compassion)

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Compassion, when strong, is a hellish feeling.

Murder, out of supreme love for humans.

4 [30]

How well you heal, savior.'4° These were her words. For the
woman loved Zarathustra.

4 [131]

We are not writing poetry here: we are doing calculations.
But we first had to write poetry in order to be able to cal-
culate.

I no longer experience anything: I am sublime, even beyond
experience.

You cold-hearted and levelheaded people, you do not know
the delights of cold-heartedness!

I remove your chains: die! – and the woman was seen smil-
ing as she died.

When Zarathustra had heard the woman's words, he cov-
ered his head and braced himself.

Isn't this compassion a kind of hell? Isn't this fervor a
kind
of flame?

the judges said in unison: this man suffers from madness:
let him go wherever he wishes: and don't let him stay. Then
Zarathustra decided on his own to return home to his cave
and to his animals.

4 [132]

having taught "recurrence" – "I forgot misery." His compas-
sion increases. He sees that the doctrine is unbearable.

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Climax: the holy murder. He invents the doctrine of superhumans.

Return home: sojourn at the hermit's "why do you not teach hard-heartedness? And hatred of what is puny?"

Zarathustra: you teach that! I am no longer that person!

I was that way when I first arrived among humans. I have grown too poor for that, – I gave away everything, even my hard-heartedness. – Hermits think this way: I swear to you with quivering lips and with the lines that agony has chiseled on my brow, with the smiles of the dying – he weeps. (May God live in this way) God is dead: and it is time

for superhumans to live.

4 [133]

To elevate to reform the concept of justice – or to prove that

human actions are necessarily unjust.

it is possible to take a position outside a particular valuation,

but not outside a// valuations.

to evaluate morality – by what standard?

4 [134]

It is certainly possible to tolerate ourselves: but what about

our neighbors? they suffer too much.

I didn't know how poor they are – I didn't know that it is more beautiful to take than to give. –

Isn't compassion God's hell? And perhaps he died of this fervor? 4 [135]*

With blood feuds: basic feeling like all those who represent the state: respect for the profound suffering of a kin-group and

concession to this feeling.

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if we combine what is harmful with horror or disgust, then the feeling evil, bad, emerges.

There are always people who love serving in dangerous posts: and without examining here the motives for this love or

just praising them any further – the free spirit – –

4 [136]!

With morality above us, life cannot to be endured at all – if

we are not Pharisees and are able to see freely – that is why I

destroyed morality.

A pile of emotions, a primum mobile, but retarded in its movement and crushed by everything that moves.

in order to affirm myself, I destroyed morality: I showed that

there are creators and tyrants everywhere at the same time.

But

this simultaneity is not needed, because the herd – – –

4 [137]

All goals are destroyed. Humans must give themselves one. It was an error that they had one: they have given themselves all of

them. But the presuppositions for all earlier goals are destroyed.

Science shows the flux, but not the goal: yet it does provide

presuppositions to which the new goal must correspond.

4 [138]!

Every human being is a creative cause of occurrences, a primum mobile with an original movement.

4 [139]

When God understood himself, he created himself and his opposite.!°°

You have indeed made the journey from worm to human!

and much within you is still worm and a memory of your journey.

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4 [140]

Icepacks. – My disgust with people had grown too great.

Likewise my counter-disgust with the moral arrogance of my idealism. I was becoming like the people I despised, I searched

within myself for everything that I despised: I wanted to dampen my ardor. I took up the cause against all the accusers

of humankind – I wrested from them and from myself the right to exalted words.

The drive to criticize wanted life –

Heroism of living on as little as possible: the desert.

Heroism of debasing our own intellectual drive, to think it through as affect.

I discredited the affects in order to say afterwards: I had an

affect, nothing more!

Life under morality not to be endured at all. (Significance of

Wagner early on)

4 [141]

W/(agner), who will endure as a h(uman being) who took
tasteless arrogance to the furthest extreme.

4 [142]!

I deny moral drives, but a//affects and drives are colored
by our
value judgments; completely different judgments are compet-
ing
within us. Result: to comprehend the multiplicity of moral-
ities.

a constant praising and blaming.

our affects speaking morally

our general feelings speaking morally

our intellectual pleasures (speaking morally)

our illnesses show up as moralistic phenomenon

everything in people is a crime, which we like or dislike

all utility

landscape

bed

a kind of illness moralis

other moral affects foregrounded on bad days

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4 [113]?

Everything we don't feel in that way makes little difference
to us. We constantly forget it.

The praise and blame of our affects, in other words valu-
ation,

is what I call "morality."

Explaining the sounds is not enough to explain music – let
alone to refute it.

There are ages in which there is appalling indifference to
human life. The opposite of this is the blood feud.

Unburdening ourselves: this is the only way we are able to
endure ourselves – and then we go mad with compassion.

4 [144]!

With shoulders squared it stands braced against the void:
and where there is space, there is being.

4 [145]

Entirely ocean, entirely noon, entirely time without goal!*>

A child, a toy And suddenly one becomes two And Zarathustra
walked past me.

4 [146]

as judge and executioner I bring about my own downfall.

4 [147]

"Good for something," "bad for something": originally all moral judgments are judgments about means to ends.°6 But gradually the ends have been forgotten, and "good" "bad" remained – as if there could be something good in itself. Praise and blame have always been given with an end in mind: but eventually the end was denied in order to be able to praise

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and blame fully completely, namely when feelings like respect

love or disgust were immediately perceived in these means.

And so it is affect that created "good in itself" and "evil in itself."

However things might stand now with these incorporated "moral feelings" – it is apparent from the history of moral feelings that no codes of goodness," no final end remains stand-

ing – everything is refuted. We have a monstrous force of moral feelings within us, but no end for anyone. They stand in

contradiction with each other – they derive from different codes of goodness, – – –

There is a monstrous moral force, but there is no longer a goal toward which all this force could be expended.

4 [148]

What can all people do? Praise and blame. This is the madness of humans, the mad animals.

I say that the fuzz goes with the peach,' I say that lies go with life.

We commit many injustices – and not only when we inflict pain but also through our praise charity compassion – we do not retaliate when it would be necessary!

4 [149]

There is only one rationality. And is there only one sensibility-

ity?! A perfectly human interpretation of the world's process

must simultaneously – or: a comforting interpretation of the world's direction has been possible for each phase of human emotion.

4 [150]

It is terrible to see how unjust things are. But at least there is

consolation in knowing that we are the creators of justice and

that we suffer on account of ourselves.

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4 [151]

Morality – the epitome of all of our incorporated value judgments: what is to become of this monstrous accumulation of force? This is the only thing that interests me about the question of how these valuations emerged.

4 [152] '°!

What do you know of the love that a lunatic has for reason?

4 [153]

(Chap(ter)) speech to those who are most intellectual. '°*

(Chap(ter)) the veiled life.

4 [154]

They have never experienced a moment that said to them, "we are pitiful"

this ancient God-made-human could not laugh.

A Hebrew named Jesus was the best at loving until now.

4 [155]!

I didn't repudiate this p(erson) that I had always admired: but rather, the reasons why I had always admired this person.

4 [156]

Conclusion of the section. And I chose for myself even this suffering on the basis of truthfulness.

4 [157]

You have seen their ideals – now shatter them yourself and be hard-hearted! Compassion.

4 [158]

Form: this p(erson) landed on top of a box that has no floor and no walls.

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4 [159]

What! You want to immortalize these miserable people? To chain them together? Just let them perish! Socialists what do

we care about the rich and the poor!

4 [160]!6%

When this timelessness'® gazes into the world, everything crooked becomes straight!

If you see blue, what good does it do you to convince yourself and say: it is gray!

to despise

4 [161]

It is difficult to say something false about women: with women nothing is impossible – answered Zarathustra.!"

4 [162]

The last humans – they wheeze and enjoy their happiness.

4 [163]

Humans are determined to stay put as super-apes, images of the last humans who are the eternal ones.

4 [164]'°%

There are enough of these people: they know nothing better on earth than to lie with a woman.

4 [165]

H(umans) are something that must be overcome: what have you done to make this happen? What do I care about your good evil h(umans)?

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4 [166]

What use is it to free the mind if it then has no wings to fly

away?

4 [167]

Last conversation with the hermit.

– I praise you for not becoming my student.

Hermit: I have too much contempt for humans, I love them too much – I cannot stand them – for both, I have to dissimulate too much.

I bring them a new love and a new contempt – superhumans and last humans.

I do not understand you – they will not accept what you bring them. Let them first beg for alms!

Zarathustra: – – –

But they need only alms, they are not rich enough to be able to need your treasures.

I write songs and sing them, I laugh and weep"? when I make my songs.

I have nothing more to teach this man.

4 [168] 171

Some want to throw dice and others want to calculate and count and still others are always wanting to see waves and dances

of waves – they call it science and sweat while they do it.

But they are children who want to have their game. And truly, it is beautiful infantile nonsense, and some laughter would not hurt the game

4 [169]?

Purpose of asceticism: to become as thirsty as possible, the creative flow must be blocked.

4 [170]

There are many things to figure out about the world: but to figure out the world – this is tedious.

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4 [x]

The antithesis of superhumans is last humans: I created one!"*

at the same time as the other.

Everything superhuman appears in humans as illness and madness.

We must already be an ocean in order to absorb a filthy stream without getting filthy.

4 [172]

When I considered purpose I also considered chance.

It has to be possible to explain the world through purposes and to explain the world through chance: through thought as much as will, through movement as much as tranquility: through God as much as the Devil. For, all of this is the I. These perspectives from which we see things are not our own; they are the perspectives of a being of the same kind as

us, a greater being: whose images we gaze into.

4 [173]

In order to learn this, I decided to hate those I loved, to blame what I had been praising up to now and to see what in the first place was good about evil and what was evil about good. I called this justice.

I finally discovered what was most difficult: not to love and

not to hate, not to praise and not to bla(me) and to say: there

is no good and there is no evil.

When I had discovered this, I went into the desert.

4 [174]!

The world stands there finished, a golden bowl!" of goodness –

yet the creative mind wants to continue creating what has already

been created– the mind invented time, and now, spinning, the world breaks apart and then, turning in great rings, spins back

together again – as the becoming of good by means of evil.

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4 [175]

You are too crude for me: it is impossible for minor experiences to be your downfall. 4 [176]'

"And indeed everything speaks quite differently to me than to you."

At the point where your honesty stops looking, your eye no

longer sees.!8°

4 [177]

History = evolution of purposes in time: such that ever higher

forms grow out of lower ones. To be explained, why ever higher forms of life have to emerge. The teleologists and Dar-

winists are in agreement that this happens. But the whole thing is a hypothesis based on value judgments – and indeed, comparatively recent value judgments. The reverse, that every-

thing until us is decline, is equally demonstrable. The human

and especially the wisest human as nature's greatest blunder and self-contradiction (the being that suffers the most): nature

has been descending until now. The organic as degeneration.

4 [178]

In my eyrie and forest. Zarathustra 4.

4 [179]

Determining value, this means the same thing as determining disvalue. In order to have the happiness of value judgments, we must also bring along all evil and all the displeasure of contempt.

This person says: the whole world is thought – will – war – love – hate: my brothers! I say to you: all these taken singly are false, all these taken together are true.

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4 [180]

Humankind must set its goal beyond itself – but not in a false X-world, rather in its own continuation.

The question: how something becomes is only meaningful for me because of the question of what it should become.

4 [181]'8'

What apes are to us, objects of painful embarrassment – so shall we be to superhumans. 4 [182]!82

How would someone have to speak to you so that you would understand! It would have to make you sick!

4 [183]'°

As soon as the will takes the stage, feeling experiences a sense of liberation. This is called freedom of the will. For feeling

is imprinted through suffering – and as soon as the will takes the stage, feeling is suspended and does not suffer

4 [18.4]!84

No sooner are you born than you have already begun to die.

4 [185]

Compassion and love opposite of morality. No justice involved!

No obedience, no duty! No love of truth and no honesty! In addition, abandoning our own way – the character of passion – and its irrationality.

4 [186]!85

Did I not invent a new smell and a new color? – Thus spoke Zarathustra.

The ocean carried you: – – –

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Who among you has the most extensive soul putting tightrope walkers on the lowest level.!86

4 [187]

And no matter where I climb, my dog follows me everywhere, the dog called “I.”

4 [188]

No I prior to the herd. Opposite of this: within superhumans,

over millennia, the You of many I’s has become one. (thus the

individuals have now become one!®”

4 [189]

The J also contains a number of entities (as in the herd) no contradiction. Likewise a plurality of forces. Occasionally pausing – invisible, like an electric current.

Striving toward compaction, it is at its strongest like a diamond, at its most creative? Really? As a people even more so?

4 [190]

They go to the charcoal burners!#® and speak to them of eternal torment.

4 [ror]!

Conversation with a King (Chap(ter)).

4 [192]

The history of great moments – this includes even teaching in front of charcoal burners. 4 [193]?

And if you are not able to squash what is small, if you do not want to be a shoo-fly:!! then go into (solitude).

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4 [194]

our eye sees things falsely, it contracts things and merges them together: is this a reason for rejecting sight and saying: it

is worthless?

4 [195]

But do you believe that Zarathustra found what he was seeking? Do you believe that a blind man walks a straight path? – And so it came to pass that this time Zarathustra did

not perish.

4 [196]!

Illness is a clumsy experiment for the sake of good health. Cut this experiment short!

4 [197]

the feeling of power, the competitive urge of all I's to find

the thought that will stay fixed above humankind as its star – the I a primum mobile.

4 [198]

Goal: for a moment, to reach superhumans. For this I will suffer everything! "That triad!

The most peaceful external life because so much is happening!

4 [199]?

Is it not a matter of indifference that as many p(eople) as possible live as long as possible?

Isn't the happiness of these many a despicable thing and no justification for existence?

Let the meaning of your life be to justify existence – and for this you will not only have to become the devil's advocate

but also even God's intercessor before the devil.

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4 [200]

He loved humans because God loves them. He wanted to redeem them in order to redeem God.

Love for humans was the cross to which he was nailed; he wanted to deliver God from his hell: which is the love of God

for humans.

4 [20]

For people are hard of hearing: and anyone who is clever beats their ears to such a pulp that they begin to hear with their eyes.

they quit laughing instead they stared at Zarathustra.

and surface everywhere, – –

4 [202]!95

Speech to the cliff – I love that it does not speak. Its silence

is dignified (Everything is moral)

4 [203]

The I knows nothing of itself in plants: it splits itself when

procreating; in many it is one (herd) it is extinguished here

– what's the significance? The coincidence!"® of the J (in different entities) irrelevant.

4 [204] (the veiled life) a pale youth

you will never discover many of them

Pine

(the last human being: a kind of Chinese)

As often as his spirit moved him, Zarathustra went up a mountain and on the way wrote down his sayings. And once,

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when he was alone with himself, he glorified himself and spoke!"

You should be like trees that hang over the ocean and bend from – – –

He walks alone; for his figures surround him, figures that he alone sees. And should he meet his equal, then their minds

embrace and with 4 eyes they see the very same figures.

whatever is just lies in my attempts to create justice for everything abhorrent to me

a tree: to shake loose the leaves and to give them small movements and to give the roots and branches the same etc.

The hermit looked at him for a long time – – –

Zarathustra, said the hermit, you have grown poor – and

if I wanted alms from you, would you really give them to me?

4 [205]

All morality has to do with inventing or seeking higher corporeal states where it is possible to bring together previously

separated abilities.

4 [206]

Pay no attention to what is good and evil – follow the path to your good and create your evil and good. There are still 1000 paths not yet taken!

4 [207]

Many minds"? are housed within humans like creatures of the sea – they battle one another for the mind "I": they love

it, they want it to climb on their backs, they hate one another

on account of this love.

198

– the I, the frisky kitten with a silver sense of animal joy.

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When has a drowning man ever suffered from thirst!

and again the kitten I squeals and again someone is happy and again all the others are envious.

A lovely consolation for those young enough for it, said a little old lady.'""

Was I born to be a preacher of repentance? Was I born to rattle on like a priest and a drum??"

4 Pos]?!

I teach you about the superhumans:

you'll have to teach yourselves.

202 the great contempt

4 [209]?°

(Chap(ter)) The Brotherhood of Justifiers. 4 [210]?°4

In good and evil they lack the shame of the spirit: and praise and blame as if

and in their spirit they lack the shame of good and evil:

They overturn icons and say: there is nothing exalted and worthy of worship – because they themselves can create neither icon nor god.

Just listen to the contempt of their rage against icons – the

great contempt for themselves!

I love souls that squander: they do not give back and do not want thanks because they are always giving gifts."

there they go forth on their own

4 [211]?°°

I am explaining even your virtues by what is to come.

It's not your virtues I'm rejecting, it's the virtuous among you.

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The friend as the best despiser and enemy.

How few are worthy!

To be a friend's conscience. To note every humiliation. To understand conscience not only in a moral sense: also taste, also to stay within one's limitations.

Friends as demons and angels. They hold the key for each others' chains. In their presence a chain falls away. They ele-

vate each other. And as an I composed of the two, they approach superhumans and rejoice at possessing friends, because

each provides for the other a second wing, without which the first would be useless.

4 [212]297

It is cool, the meadow lies in shadow, the sun has departed. Is it not absurd to live? Wouldn't we have to have more reason in order to make something reasonable out of life?

My brothers, forgive the soul of Zarathustra for the fact that it is evening. 4 [213]?

The invention of conditions

It is high time that humans set themselves a goal. They are still rich and wild enough for the most exalted goal. I say to

you: you still have the chaos and world-collisions within you

that are needed to give birth to a dance of the stars.

But someday humans will become too poor, someday they will no longer have enough momentum and drive even for the fury of contempt.

4 [214]

Our contempt for h(umans) drove us beyond the stars. Religion, metaphysics, as symptom of a desire to create superhumans.

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4 [215]?!

Humankind is walking around pregnant, how quaint the pregnant are!

4 [216]

(Chap(ter)) Prove yourself to me! Which duty is yours?

4 [217]

1. The emphasis on states and the striving for them. Significance for the body.

2. This particular attitude of the I toward itself emerges, in

which the herd-type remains preserved.

The outbreak of entire reform movements as correctives of the body.

What does asceticism mean?

Buddhism and monasticism as the production of healthy bodies (countering the destructive and debilitating affects).

Morality as a language of metaphors about an unknown region of corporeal states. – Here the talk (is) still entirely of

will and purpose and of nothing else at all.

2. The adaptation of the body to a climate brings about the manifestation of moralities.

That which is the perishing of the type and immorality.
thus altering the body apparently without chemical means
— — in truth, morality is (about) changing the chemical composition of the body.

Monstrous detour. In what way might it be possible to proceed more directly?

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"Concept of health and ideal of health dependent on the goal of human beings" — ? but the goal itself is an expression

of a particular composition of the body and its conditions.
The body and morality.

4 [218]

And he did not know how to overcome his virtue.

The lion within him tore apart the child within him: and finally the lion devoured itself.

This hero was cruel and wild — — —

Behold, I teach you the love for superhumans.

— — — he took it upon himself and shattered under the burden.

4 [219]

Passions = states of our organs and their aftereffect on the brain — along with seeking release.

4 [220]

He was called a sage, but he was nothing of the kind.

4 [221]

In earlier times, the position of religion in relation to nature was

reversed: religion reflected the popular understanding of nature.

Now the popular understanding is the materialistic one.

There-

fore whatever there is of religion must now speak the same way to

the people: materialistically.

4 [222]

squarely built, with a strong neck
using the lion to kill the lion tamer

4 [223])"

You should not want to have many virtues — you are not rich enough for that. One virtue is already a lot of virtue: in

order for it to live, you must already be perishing.

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4 [224]?!

I live so that I know: I want to know so that superhumans

may live.

We experiment for them!

4 [225]

The thoroughly creative character of everything that happens — — —

The freedom of the will is much more convincingly demonstrated than cause and effect (in truth cause effect is only a

popular conclusion)

4 [226]

We are too tolerant of bad air: and you yourself are bad air for other people.

Three or 2.

Whoever does not make us fertile?!

4 [227]

A quest for whatever it is about the truth that hurts me, and

sacrificing everything, a monstrous tension

nothing in my head but a personal morality: and to establish my right to it is the meaning of all my historical questions

about morality. (For it is terribly difficult to establish this right

for ourselves!) 4 [228]2!4

I love humans who bring?" about the downfall of their virtue.

behold, I show you the bridge to the superhumans!

(I love those) who squander their souls, who do not thank and never give back because they are always giving gifts.'°

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4 [229]?'7

Those who justify the people of the future and redeem the people of the past.

And those who are compassionate should create out of this their duty and doom, and those who are loyal should let loyalty become their duty and their doom — and you cannot have enough ingenuity?' for your virtue.

Let your life be an experiment — let your failures and successes be proof: but take care that people know how you have experimented and what you have proven.

they said: let us make ourselves dead to the world, they sought their salvation beyond the stars — they have not heard

a word about superhumans.

They maligned their health, — — —

There is so much about your good people that disgusts me,

and truly not what is evil about them."

I wish they had a madness that would mean their downfall,
as the pale criminal's madness meant his,
I wish their madness were called compassion or loyalty or
justice.

But they have their virtue in order to live a long time, — —
back then there was doubt, the search for justice, compas-
sion for friends — —

4 [230]?

And his scholar should be a penitent of the mind.
And his speech displeased everyone except for one person.
Interaction.

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Scholars

A call to stand alone and to talk your way out of things!

4 [231]

The right to my own values — where did I get this? From
the rights of all old values and from the limits of these
values.

4 [232]

The point of marriage: a child that represents a type super-
ior

to the parents.

NB. they must despise you as you move above and beyond
them — they do not understand what it is to be above
ourselves.

You yearn for love — but, no, you must learn to endure
contempt.

You set your hearts on money and you yourselves are losing
your hearts. Railroad and state are to the advantage of many
and are their doom.

For those who do not belong to the many.

You are losing your caution, your lynx eyes and your bear
claws.

4 [233]

Value terminology is a banner planted where a new blissful-
ness was invented — a new feeling.

4 [234]?!

Sometimes I want from you: that you be profoundly clever
and that you be profoundly proud: then your pride will al-
ways

accompany your cleverness. You will walk the paths of fool-
ish-

ness: yet I call even upon your foolishness, that it may al-
ways

take pride as its escort. But if you want to be foolish

- - -

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Do I recommend to you loving thy neighbor? I much prefer
to recommend fearing thy neighbor and loving those far away.
I discovered a new land in humans

where the soul overflows

you show me a brush and a j(a)r full of paint and say: we
have refuted the picture.

Society is decaying. the dreaming future

You are fleeing yourselves: and always you move out of the
fry-

ing pan of self-contempt into the fire??? of loving thy
neighbor.

Cats and wolves should also be my role models: they are
more self-possessed.

(Shoo-flies) for the little annoyances of daily life.

4 [235]

A god who proves his existence poorly is as good as a god
who does not prove his existence at all.

This is a god who proves his existence either not at all or
poorly.

When 100 stand together, all of them lose their minds and
acquire different ones.

Oh these impoverished friendships! Whatever they do for
their friends, I promise to do for my enemies – and I do not
want to have become poorer.

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4 [236]

And just as a child uses his little foot to push a glass
shard in

front of him, so life propels us foolishly forward.

4 371°"

Yes, laden with heavy burdens, I hurried into my desert: but
there I found for the first time my heaviest burden of all.
to be the smith and anvil of our own virtue, the judge and
touchstone of our own worth.

There are many heavy burdens and when I was young I did
a lot of searching for the heaviest one.

Yes, I fled into the desert – and there in the most isolated
desert, I found for the first time my heaviest burden of
all.

This heaviest burden – this became what was most pre-
cious to me, like a god I taught that my heaviest burden
should be revered.

sighed deeply and spoke no more.

4 [238]?

And when someone does you a great injustice, then see to it only that you also do that person a small injustice in return,
it's humane that way.

4 [239]

And you believe that justice will already be limping along after you?

4 [240]?

There is more reason in your body than in your reason. And even that which you call wisdom, – who knows why your body needs just this wisdom?

4 [241]

I realized that shepherds and breeders of herds created these

codes: in this way they gave a foundation to the life and con-

tinuation of their herds.

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4 [242]?

Yes, I bore all of this burden! I knelt down and loaded all of

this burden upon myself, like a camel I bowed my head and hurried away into the desert.

Where are the truths that cause suffering? I exclaimed.

The first one was the dragon and he spoke: "The worth of all things is worthless," "Contradiction is at the heart of all values"

At that point I recognized the origin of good and evil: and that humankind lacks the goal.

To give myself the right to name things with new names and values, was the heaviest burden.

I envied all plants – I envied even all ghosts.

To shatter the tablets of values with superior values my own tablets I set beside the others – how much courage and fear it took!

4 [243]

you are the despisers of the body

4 [244]

I looked into the eyes of these greatest ones and crawled into their souls. Alas!!! – Depiction of geniuses and saints.

Concerning the question whether {they}??? have existed already! – If they did, then the earth knew nothing of it.

4 [245]?

The preachers of the slow death are venerated the most.

4 [246]

(Chap(ter)) What became Zarathustra's heaviest burden?
To disengage himself from the ancient morality.

4 [247]

Chap(ter). Do you want a reward? What you want as a reward is for me the measure of your virtue.

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4 [248]

I gave a new color to (the) earth – I spread the veil of a new
hope across the earth.

4 [249]?

Blood founds churches: what does blood have to do with truth! And if you want my approval, then prove it to me with reasons and not with blood.

4 [250]

(Chap(ter)) Puny people. Go forth into solitude, you cannot endure a small shower of raindrops.

4 [251]

and suddenly it opens its eyes, the eyes of a child and of a blossom. What happened? The hand of a creative one touched it. The sun of a creative one revealed the god that was concealed.

4 [252]

I brought those lost in flight back down to earth and to their huts: at the heights I taught them depth.

4 [253]°7°

Tell me, where have they gone, these dear sages? Do their eyes not grow heavy? – Here and there a few such sages are still around you: they preach good and evil in soft voices. Blessed are these sleepy ones.

4 [254]

Have there already been superhumans? Value of our culture.

4 [255]

they spin on the edge of earthliness and their keen eyes grow blind in this twilight.

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4 [256]

To invent a thousand new ways to live – no longer just for herds!

4 [257]"'

She is betraying lock, stock and barrel??? – that's what's so

vile! We must learn to ennoble what is vile.

4 [258]

yearning and questioning and only shedding tears etc. –
Against religious people.

it is no longer honest. It is not sufficient for faith!
Therefore: after this position," renunciation!

4 [259]

I want to hear your dominant thought and not only that
you have escaped a kind of insanity.

Are you the sort of people who are allowed to escape from a
kind of insanity? Or did you toss aside your last value when
you threw away your servitude . . .

Free, from what? – why should this even matter to Zarathus-
tra

when you squint at the question: free for what?

I want to hear your dominant thought, so that it may exon-
erate you in my presence! – or I will have my thoughts
strike

your ears like scourges.

4 [260]?34

A sun, with the serpent of knowledge coiled in rings around
it.

4 [261]

"that which is earthly' – you must learn to perceive it
differently.

Lay aside the false measures of value that were taken from
an unknown world

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Humans stand tall – – per(haps) superior beings will sud-
denly be achieved!

4 [262]

(Chap(ter)) The alleged love of God and "everything to our
advantage"

4 [263]

The good it wants to preserve itself by means of the ancient

4 [264]

They dearly wish to escape: yet they cannot find any way to
other stars, so they believe that there are subterranean
ways

– of a completely different kind and as it were secret ways.

– Rare conditions were felt to be superterrestrial. Delight
and

convulsions combined.

To me your love is not abundant enough to be a love of the
universe!

Our feelings – this is the entire human past up until you
and me: the values that have been created.

Our more lofty feelings – we would have to eradicate them
if we don't give them a new goal!

If it weren't for this dreary cloud in the sky, you wouldn't

have dreary knowledge either!

4 [265]

My direction for art: don't continue writing poetry in the margins! the future of humanity instead! There must be many pictures out there that can model ways to Jive!

4 [266]??? Against hinterworlders.

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Your life an experiment and monument to your experiment.

Artists helped to ensure that life was not improved. In most cases artists themselves the victims of their works.

penitents of the mind?*° the one who creates

4 [267]

Some sacrifice is involved in giving up this hinterworld. Manliness!

What is earthly is not enough for us – therefore what is heavenly – flawed conclusion.

Nature denies you this intrusion!

In the beginning a wrinkled tuber, and a noxious??” root drenched with many poisons – every feeling.

4 [268]

someone who creates is someone who creates new values.

But not the artist!

4 [269] the gathering of individuals (festival)

4 [270]

Gods, I have a bow! What a bow – a good bow against gods themselves!

4 [271]??®

The great test: are you ready to justify life Or your own death?

At the lowest level still enduring it.

Illness led many to take this second way.

Renunciation.

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The great halfway point. – The decision about wanting to live or die.

4 [272]

State and church, and everything that is founded on lies, serve the preachers of death.

4 [273]

you think the solution to your riddle must be in the dark! But consider the destiny of a worm. The solution lies in your

goal and in your hope: it's your will!

No God has ever intervened! But you have subjugated yourselves too much to convention, even to nature.

But the knowing one??? sees how every love and sun has

bowed down to ugly weeds.

4 [274]

Many an ostrich has buried its head in the thinnest layer of sand.

4 [275]?

Whenever you stepped from a lower virtue up to a higher one — — —

I want to be the first to give you your dignity: you ought to

be penitents of the mind!

Ruins should not be destroyed: grass and roses and tiny herbs and whatever residue of life decorates these ruins, all of

this destroys even what is dead.

This I has been most convincingly demonstrated, this I that contradicts itself.

Truly the world is well concealed from h(umans). The belly of existence? *! will never speak to h(umans)!

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For what reason did I tell you this? In this way the /iar has

become the signpost of the superhumans.

Separation

4 [276]

The decision. There must be countless sacrifices. An experiment.

4 [277]

Even the sweetest woman tastes bitter.

4 [278]

If the good?" of the many is our good, then we should not call it virtue when we do good for the many. On loving thy neighbor.

4 [279]

So punch your way out of this false stargazing nonsense!

The belly of existence will never speak to you.

4 [280]243 3 Transform(ations) Sleep and Virtue 1001 goal the despisers of the body. Hinterworld. our own virtue. On the Pale Criminal the tree on the mountain Reading and Writing. Preachers of Death. The New Idol. Z(arathustra's) Solitude 1. Friend. Soldiers. Loving thy Neighbor.

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Chastity.

Path of Those Who Create. Women.

Viper's Bite.

Marriage.

Death.

on holy selfishness.

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[5 = ZI 2a. Mp XV 3a.

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s u!

1 Will to live? I have always found only will to power in its place.?

2. The constant zeal for a cause, even the highest, our own, betrays a lack of spiritual refinement, as do all things that rest

on unconditional faith: for the emblem of this is always – a cool gaze.

3. I consider all people harmful who are no longer capable of

opposing that which they love: this is how they corrupt the best things and persons.

4. There are persons who would like to force everyone into a yes or no with respect to their entire character: Rousseau was

one of them: the megalomania they suffer from originates in their insane mistrust of themselves.

5. We must overcome even the youth in ourselves in order to become children again.?

6. It is with our intentions that we rationalize our in-compre-

hensible drives to ourselves: as, e.g., murderers do when they

justify to their reason their actual compulsion to murder, namely, by deciding to commit a robbery or to take revenge.

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7. The pleasure that all morality has conveyed up to now and still conveys – in other words the pleasure that morality has

accumulated up to now – lies in the right it gives everyone to

praise and blame, without extensive evaluation. And who could bear life without praising and blaming!

8. This is the crux for moral pessimists: if they were serious

about wanting to help their brothers toward redemption, then they would have to decide to make their brothers' existence miserable, in other words (to) be their unhappiness; out of compassion they would have to – become evil!

If it were true that life does not deserve to be affirmed, then

moral people would be abusing their neighbors precisely by using self-denial and helpfulness – for their most personal gain.

9. I want to know whether you are a creative or a productive person in any particular way: as a creative person you belong among free people, as a productive person you are their slave and their tool.

10. As much as possible and this as quickly as possible: this is what is demanded by the great intellectual and emotional malady that is sometimes called “the present,” sometimes “education,” in truth it is nothing but a symptom of consumption.’

11. Women and geniuses don’t work. Up until now women have been humankind’s greatest extravagance. In those moments where we do our best, we don’t work. Work is only a means to these moments.

12. We are most unfair not toward that which displeases us, but rather toward that which does not concern us at all.®

13. No sooner do we take even one step beyond average human goodness than our actions arouse suspicion. For virtue rests “in the mean.””

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14. You say “we like this” and think you are praising me. Oh you fools! How much I like it when you do this!®

15. Of everything that has been written I love only what people write with their blood. This is why I love books. Affects are nothing to be ashamed of, they are too irrational for that.

16. The affects are a relief for those who are frequently burdened by their rationality; namely, as a kind of irrationality.

17. This century loves to ascribe to its most intellectual men a taste for immature, mentally deficient and modest little girls of the people, Faust’s taste for Gretchen – this speaks against the taste of the century and of its most intellectual men.

18. As if that weren’t bad enough! The time for marriage

comes much earlier than the time for love: the latter regarded

as the measure of maturity, in men and women.

19. When a woman attacks a man, it is only to defend herself against a woman. When a man becomes friends with a woman, she thinks he's doing it because he can't get any further with her.!°

20. It is impossible to suffer without having someone pay for

it; every single complaint contains revenge."

21. My brothers and sisters, do not act so delicately toward me! We are all comely sturdy male and female donkeys and truly no trembling rosebuds for whom a mere dew drop seems too much!!?

22. Life is hard to bear: but why else would we have our defiance in (the) morning and our surrender in the afternoon?!

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23. I am astounded: I often don't get hungry until after a meal.!4

24. Truly, not the least of a theory's charms is the fact that it

is refutable.!

25. These constitutional monarchs were thought to be virtuous: since then they can no longer "commit injustice" – but in return they were stripped of their power.!°

26. Those fortunate enough to remain obscure should also take advantage of the freedoms that darkness affords and, especially, "whisper well."

27. To actually attribute the unpleasant consequences of our own folly to folly and not to our lack of character – this requires more character than most people have.'®

28. Scientific people share the fate of rope-makers: they weave

their strand longer and longer, but in the process they themselves move – backwards."

29. For me, the worst thing is not to fall into his hands: but

into his thoughts."

30. To experience a lot: a lot of the past included; to experience a lot of our own and others' experiences as an integ-

rated

whole: this shapes the most superior humans; I call them
"totalities."?!

Good people are brakes: they obstruct, they preserve."

4 25

(33.) "Honorable men"? are offensive to my taste.

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(34.) To become illustrious in 300 years – that is my thirst
for glory."

(35.) Do I love music? I don't know: too often I also find
my-

self hating it. And yet music does love me, and no sooner
does

someone leave me than music jumps into my lap and wants to
be loved.?"

(36.) They do not love me: is this a reason not to bless
them?78

37. "Behold! The world has just now become perfect": that's
what every woman thinks when she obeys out of total
devotion."

It is true that the earth became warmer when the forests
were

thinned out and cleared – —*°

Justice would be done if petty thieves, petty backbiters and
detractors were hanged.?!

40. We shouldn't use one word to categorize contemptible
people together with terrible people.??

41. Affects that are evil and great shake us to the core and
overthrow everything that is rotten and small within us: you
must first experiment with the possibility of not being
great.

42. Our delicate feelings keep us deluded and make us de-
pressed,

let's say this openly: "I like it this way – I don't care
why!"

43. In regard to most truths, women have the feeling that
someone wants to look under their skin.??

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44. In addition to our ability to judge we also have our
opinion

of our ability to judge.

45. You lack the courage to burn yourself up and to become
ashes: and so you will never become new and never become
young again!?*

46. Marriage is designed for average people who are not cap-
able

of either extraordinary love or extraordinary friendship, in other words, for most people: but also (for) those very rare individuals

who are capable of both love and friendship.'

47. You lovers of knowledge! So what have you done up until now out of love of knowledge? Have you ever stolen and murdered in order to know how it feels to be a thief and a murderer?*°

48. Lies have also been told about the value of knowledge: those who know have always cited it in their defense – they always found themselves extremely marginalized and almost criminalized.*"

49. To become as close to a friend as possible without surrender-

ing to the friend entirely! We (should) honor even the enemy

in our friends.*®

50. The more abstract the truth you want to teach, the more you have to seduce even the senses into embracing it.

51. The subtlety of compassion consists in discerning whether

the sufferer really wants compassion.

52. "Obedience" and "law" – these ring out from all moral feelings. But, in the end, "choice" and "freedom" could still

become the death knell of morality.

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53. A child as the monument to the passion of two persons; a twosome's will to oneness.??

54. We must endure our thirst and let it become acute: otherwise-

wise we will never discover our wellspring, which can never be

another's!

55. You must raise even your devil to greatness: that way you

rid yourself of petty deviltry.*°

56. The great epochs of our life are to be found wherever we find the courage to rebaptize our evil as good.*!

57. Even truthfulness is just one of the means to knowledge, a

ladder – but not the ladder."

58. The will to overcome an affect is, in the final analysis, only

the will of another affect.*

59. Those who themselves possess the will to suffer are differently disposed to cruelty: they no longer take it to be in itself damaging and bad."

60. Persons who were employed in an enterprise that has failed should be doubly compensated.

61. Heroism – this is the mentality of people who pursue goals that, logically speaking, they have no chance of achieving. H(eroism) is self-destruction in good faith.*°

62. The enormous expectations that women bring to sexual love ruin for them all additional perspectives."

63. Those who no longer find greatness in God no longer find greatness at all – they must deny it or create it.*®

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64. Unconditional love also contains – the desire to be mistreated: in that case love defies itself, and out of devotion there

grows at last even the wish for self-destruction: "Perish in the

depths of this ocean!" ®

65. Lust and self-mutilation are neighboring drives. Even among those who know there are self-mutilators: they do not want to be creative at all.*°

66. There are temperaments" that can find no way of living with themselves except by striving for their own downfall."

67. The closer you come to being completely coldhearted in regard to everything that was previously valued, the closer you

also come to a new warmheartedness."

68. Every good is the transformation of an evil: every god has

a devil for a father.*4

69. "What must I do to become blessed?" I don't know, but I say to you: be blessed® and then do whatever you want."

70. Something becomes dear to us: and no sooner have we come to love it with all our hearts than that tyrant within us

calls out: "give me that very thing as a sacrifice" – and we give it."

71. I urge you to battle, not to work, I urge you to victory, not

to peace. May your work be a battle, your peace a victory.

72. I awoke you from sleep: for I saw that a nightmare was oppressing you. And now you are out of sorts and tell me:

"what should we do now? Night is still all around us!" – you ungrateful ones! You should go back to sleep and dream better"?

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73. Every church is the stone on the grave of a God-made-human: the last thing it wants is for him to be resurrected.
°°

Everything about women is a riddle, everything about women has one solution: it is called pregnancy.°!

But even the serpent itself was one of God's prejudices.

75. What's the point! Apparently you don't understand anything other than barking and biting – so at least be my dog – said Zarathustra.

I also know what is beyond evil and good – said Zarathustra."

77. Today I love myself as I love my God: who could forgive me a sin today? I know only sins against my God; yet who knows my God?®

78. Do you want to have an easy life? Then always stay with the herd and lose yourself in the herd. –°°

79. In war, personal revenge is silent."

81. Don't look at the sun! The moon is still too bright for your nocturnal eyes!"

82. You say: "this is dark." And in truth: I placed a cloud in

front of your sun. But don't you see how the edges of the cloud

are already shining and becoming bright?"°

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84. There they stand over there, the puny people, like grass and weeds and undergrowth – blameless in their pitifulness. And now I creep through them and crush as few as I can – but at the same time disgust eats away at my heart."

85. What sustained me, you ask? Always pregnancy and nothing else. And every time a work was born, my life hung by a thin thread."

86. Disgust at filth can become so great that it discourages us

from cleansing ourselves.'*

87. As one who creates, you live above and beyond yourself – you cease being your contemporary."

88. Alas, you wanted to have it better than good! This is your folly."

89. We can only be silent when we have bows and arrows:

otherwise we babble and bicker.'" "

go. I assume that you are compassionate: to be without compassion means to be sick in mind and body. But we must have a strong mind before we are allowed to be compassionate. For your compassion is damaging to you and to all."8

91. I love compassion that is hidden under a hard shell: I love compassion that makes people bite so hard they break off their teeth."

92. A false saying goes as follows: "those who cannot redeem themselves, how could they redeem others?" But if I have the key to your shackles, why would your lock and mine have to be the same?8?

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93. Once war begins, you will become holy, even if you are brigands and cruel.®!

94. ("A uniform" is what they call it, what they wear: uniformity is what they mean by it.)®?

heart than the tyrant within me says: "I want that very thing y y y 8

as a sacrifice." This cruelty is in my guts. You see: I am evil.

96. You say, a good cause is that which justifies even war? I

say: war is that which justifies every cause!*4

97. Reason is an exception even in me, said Zarathustra: chaos and necessity and whirling of the stars – this is the rule even in the wisest of worlds.®

98. We should make our death into a festival, even if only out

of malice toward life: toward this woman who wants to leave us – us!86

99. We both have something for each other: how wonderful it is to disagree in this – you have the passion, I the reasons!®"

I am great enough not to be ashamed of them.

101. "There is no one alive who would be worthy of praising me. And whom may Zarathustra not praise?"®?

I milked the milk out of the udder of my misery."°

103. I have exposed myself and am not ashamed to stand here this naked. Shame is the name of the ghoul who became a companion of humans when they were seized with the desire to transcend animals. ("Speech to the Animals")!"

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Zarathustra care???

105. I came to help you, and you complain that I don't want to weep with you."

106. All god-humans created their own gods: and there is no greater enmity on earth than that between gods."

107. Acknowledge your own will, and say to us all, "this is the

only thing I want to be": set above yourself your own law of punishment: we want to be the ones who carry it out!

108. If you are too weak to make laws for yourselves: then a tyrant should lay his yoke on you and say: "obey, grind your teeth and obey" – and everything good and evil should drown in obedience to him.

109. Give back and pay back; pay back richly, good and bad – be modest in accepting, let your accepting be a mark of distinction.'

uo. Be careful with cats: they never give, they do not even pay back – they only reply and purr in the process.'

1. Tell me, you birds, who travel widely and see many who are concealed: who among humans has the most extensive soul? the most extensive souls are like small countries?"

112. You are still perfectly innocent in your admiration: you

do not believe that you can ever be admired."

113. I am speaking and a child is playing: who can be more serious than the both of us???

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114. You have overcome yourself: but why are you showing yourself to me merely as someone who has been overcome? I want to see the victor: throw roses into the abyss and speak: "A

gesture of thanks to the monster because it did not know how to devour me!"

115. There you sit on the beach, freezing and hungry: it is not

enough to have saved your !° life!

116. Who would believe it of me, spoke Zarathustra, that I belong to a race of berserkers, and to a race of libertines, of

religious fanatics, of those obsessed with revenge? But war has

justified me.!!

117. Happiness for men lies in "I will this," happiness for women in "I must."!°?

118. Even the best man is fundamentally evil below: even the

best woman is fundamentally bad below.!"

119. I have to be an angel if all I want is to live: but you live

under other conditions.!"%

120. Those who say to their god: I want to put all my evil too

at your service – are the most pious people.!"

121. You say I should be your teacher! See to it that I am your

wings and not your stumbling block.!"®

What do I care about the purring of those who, like cats, are incapable of love?

123. Many a deed is done in order to forget another deed: some actions work like opium. I am here so that another is forgotten.!"8

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124. I am doing what I love best and for that very reason I am

loath to describe it with fancy words: I don't want (to) dare to

believe that it is a sublime compulsion, a law that I obey: I love

what I love best too much to want to show myself as being compelled to do it.

126. In my view, you have become too life-impooverished: now you want to make austerity into virtue itself.

127. Golden era, when arrogance was considered to be the wellspring of evil!!!°

128. You should preserve chaos within you: all those yet to come must have material out of which they can form themselves.!!!

129. Don't let yourselves be deceived! The most active peoples

feel the greatest fatigue, their discontent is weakness – they

no longer have the substance required for waiting and for laziness.!!?

130. Just for today, destiny, give me the unluckiest roll of your

dice. Today I turn everything into gold."

131. No one comes to see me anymore. And I myself: I went to see everyone, but I came to see no one!!4

132. Thinking of life should be the focus of recuperation: other-

wise thinking only of the work we have to do!!!

133. We must be as good at being cruel as we are at being

compassionate: let us guard against becoming poorer than nature!!!

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134. "I could spare nothing when I created superhumans. All of your evil and falsehood, your lies and your ignorance, are

still in their semen."!!"

135. Let humans be the impetus for something that is no longer human! You want species-preservation? I say: species-overcoming!!!8

136. Do I really want to create lamb-souls and visionary vir-

gins? Lions are what I want and monsters of force and love.!!!?

137. The point must be reached!?!° where humanity's greatest festivals are procreation and death!!!"!

138. We must prepare not just the earth for superhumans but also the animals and plants.!!?°

139. The best things amount to nothing until an actor has "performed" them.!!?°

140. "You must be inoculated with the madness" – said Zarathustra.

141. I still have all these wild dogs at my place, but in my cel-

lar. I do not want to ever hear them bark.!!?5

142. Thinking of life should be the focus of recuperation: other-

wise we should think only of the work we have to do.!!?°

143. Honor actors for my sake and don't ever look for the best

ones on stage!!?7

145. You are waging war? You fear your neighbor? So remove the border markers: then you will have no more neighbors.

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But you want war: and that's why you set up the border markers

in the first place.!!"?°

146. "This is how I want to live, illuminated by the virtues of

a world that has yet to exist."!?!°

147. Every thing has two faces, one of passing away and one of

becoming.'?!°

148. This good discerning exacting sense found in knowledge, which you in no way want to make into a virtue, is the flower-

ing of many virtues: but the "thou shalt" from which it sprang is no longer visible, its roots lie beneath the earth.!??

149. Love is the fruit of obedience: but often generations lie between the fruit and the root: and freedom is the fruit of love!

150. The freer and more grounded individuals are, the more demanding their love becomes: in the end they yearn for superhumans because nothing else quenches their love.

151. Don't reveal yourself! And if you must, then in rage and not in shame!!*4

152. Did I come to teach you how to defend yourselves against burglars and cutthroats? I speak to those who are tired of their virtues and who will allow themselves to be robbed or killed to experience it just once.!35

153. And have you nothing more to say to human beings? his disciples asked. "No," said Zarathustra, "the cup is empty." And when he had said this, he went on his way, alone. Yet those who saw him go, wept.!%°

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154. Beware of insulting hermits: they never forgive. A hermit is like a deep well: it is easy to toss a stone into it: yet how would you propose to retrieve it once it reached the bottom???

155. Be humane toward those who create! It is their nature to know little of loving thy neighbor.!?®

wronged: and with profound people all experiences last a long time. 139

time.

157. Each action by a superior human being breaks your moral law a hundred times.!4°

158. I can still stand on the narrowest stoop of life: but who would I be if I showed you this skill? Do you wish to see a tightrope walker?!4!

159. Ah, what a lap of luxury you live in! You have a law – and a nasty look for anyone who even thinks about opposing it. For our part we are free: what do you know of the agony

that results from taking responsibility for oneself –!*?
 160. I teach you redemption from eternal flux: the flux also flows back into itself again and again, and you always step into the same flux again and again, as the same people.!*?
 161. I taught myself this: humans gave themselves all of morality: although they now believe that they merely received it. Well then! We, too, can still give ourselves a good and an evil!!⁴⁴
 162. What is it that humans find most difficult to do? To love those who despise us: to abandon our cause when it is celebrating its triumph: to renounce reverence for the sake of truth; to be ill and turn away anyone who wishes to comfort
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 183 us; to wade into cold and dirty water; to make friends with doves; to extend a hand to a ghost who terrifies us: – all of this, said Zarathustra, I have done, and I carry it with me: and all of this I give away today at a bargain price – for the smile of a child.!!%
 Didn't I know of the speechless eyes of all the injured?
 164. Even as animals we should be perfect – said Zarathustra.!"
 166. I love free minds when their hearts are free as well. My head is like the stomach of the heart – but we should have a good stomach. What the heart accepts, the head must digest.!!*®
 167. It is not enough to have a talent: we must also be allowed to have it!!⁴?
 168. Compassion a hellish feeling: compassion is itself the cross to which those who love human beings are nailed.!!°°
 169. Keep your souls fresh and cool and raw! May you remain far from the lukewarm air of those people full of feeling, from the stale humid air of sentimental people!!>!
 170. "Shrouded in heavy sadness: my life hangs on small coincidences." The hermit.)
 171. When we suffer a lot, we might finally become humble

enough to be vain – said the hermit: he opened his mouth reluctantly, he usually preferred to grit his teeth.!?
172. “I do not give alms – I am not poor enough for that” – said Zarathustra.!!®

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173. I am a support and a balustrade along a mighty river: grab onto me whoever can! – I am not a crutch.!?

174. “Humans should be the midpoint between plants and ghosts.”

175. Blood is a poor witness for truth: blood poisons a doctrine so that it becomes a kind of hatred.!?7

177. Murderous desire, hatred, mistrust are now phenomena that accompany bodily illness: this is how much moral judgments have been incorporated in us. – In barbaric times, cowardice and compassion might appear to be symptoms of illness. Perhaps virtues can also be symptoms; – – –!”

178. This is how humans are: a new force, a first movement:
a

self-revolving wheel; if they were strong enough, they would make the stars revolve around themselves.!!®

179. With shoulders squared, space stands braced against the void. Where there is space, there is being.’

180. You told me what a sound is and what an ear is: but what

does this have to do with artists of sounds? Have you explained

music by saying this – or refuted it instead?!°?

181. There are no moral drives,! but all drives are colored by

our value judgments.

183. When horror consorts with what is harmful, evil emerges;

when disgust consorts with it, bad emerges.!!®

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184. Zarathustra: “As long as your morality hung over me, I breathed like someone suffocating. And so I strangled this serpent. I wanted to live, that’s why it had to die.!!66

185. What is a human being? A pile of passions that reach out

into the world through the senses and the mind: a tangle of wild serpents seldom growing tired of the struggle: then they

gaze out into the world to find their prey.!!°

186. It is impossible to live without assigning value: but it is

possible to live without assigning value to what you value.

187. Now the lead weight of their guilt lies upon them: they are so ponderous, so stiff: if only they could shake their heads,

it would roll off. But who will move these heads?!©*

188. I want to force you to think like a human being: a necessity

for those human beings who can conceptualize human beings. The necessity of having gods would not be true for you.'

189. The force of praise and blame is monstrous: but where is

the goal that could devour this force?

190. And what was too foul to feed to your dogs – this is precisely what you threw to your God. Perhaps he died from your diet?

191. Your souls lack the frankincense of shame: but even a good peach has its fuzz.!"°

192. When storm clouds gather, you should lay your resolutions to rest.

193. We should question gods only in cases where gods alone can answer.

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194. Before destiny strikes us, we should lead it around like a

child and – not spare the rod: yet once we meet it, then we should seek to love it.

195. It seemed godless to our ancestors and insatiably greedy

that we should grub around for treasure in the bowels of the earth.!"!

197. The greatest sacrilege is the sacrilege against humans after

there are no more gods: and of devaluing what is human in favor of the entrails of unknowable things.!"

198. Become necessary! Become lucid! Become beautiful! Become

well!!74

Some love a bird in flight and others see only dawns and oceans.

200. to become active on behalf of great matters and otherwise to be slow and – – –

201. Do I love the past? I destroyed it in order to live. Do I

love my contemporaries? I look away from them in order to be able to live.

202. Incapable of believing in something for long!: knowledge!' loses its value the moment it is acquired. Therefore

create!

Creating above and beyond ourselves! This is the drive of pro-creation, this is the drive of deeds and of works. – Just as all

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willing presupposes a purpose, so do human beings presuppose beings who (are) not there, but who supply the purpose of their

existence. This is the freedom of all willing! In purpose lies

love, reverence, seeing completely, longing.

Praise of the forest. Blessed be this tree where I thought of you

Becoming accustomed to gratitude.

you should not kill before the animal is not dozing.!"

Sentenced to be executioners, you scholars!

204. I was afraid when I was among humans: something demanded that I join them and nothing gave me rest. Then I went into solitude and created superhumans. And as I created them, I arranged for them the great veil of becoming and let the noon shine all around them.

For the sake of this moment, I endure the recurrence.

206. What is it that imparted sense, worth, meaning to things? The creative heart that desired and created out of desire. It created pleasure and pain. It wanted to satiate itself

even with pain. We must take upon ourselves, and affirm, all suffering that has ever been felt by humans and animals, and we must have a goal whereby suffering preserves reason.

207. There is no redemption for those who suffer on account of their existence except that of no longer suffering on account

of their existence. How do they attain this? Through sudden death or through enduring love.'

188 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

208. Every action continues to create us, it weaves our cloak of

many colors. Every action is free, but a cloak is necessary. Our

experience – this is our cloak.

209. Desire is happiness: satiation as happiness is merely the

last moment of desire. To be entirely a wish is happiness and

to be a new wish again and again.!"?

210. I converse with you, my wisdom, just the two of us: / will, I desire, I love – and this is why I praise life. If I didn't create, but I only knew, I would hate life.

211. Not doing, letting go, not creating, not destroying – this is my evil. The one who knows also as the one who does not desire.

212. Emptiness, oneness, motionlessness, fullness, satisfaction, not-willing – this would be my evil: in short: sleep without dreams.!®°

Love for the corporeal and for the world is the consequence of

knowing as willing. As creating, all knowing is not-knowing. Seeing through things would be death, disgust, evil. There is no

other form of knowing than that of first creation. To be a subject – 181

214. The greatest danger is faith in knowing and faith in being

known,?' i.e., faith that creating has ended. This is the great fatigue. "It is nothing."!®

215. All knowing, as creating, never ends. To each person there would have to correspond an explanation of the world that would belong to that person completely: to that person as

a first movement. We never want to admit this to ourselves and we look to the herd.

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216. Injustice has not been done until we do something to help someone: justice and injustice do not have to do with helping and hurting, but rather with advantage and harm.!84

217. You will be called destroyers of morality: but you are merely the inventors of yourselves.

218. These are my enemies: they want to overthrow things and not to develop themselves. They say: "all of this is worth-

less" – and do not want to create any value themselves.

«C »

219. I am "the awakened one": and you – no sooner are you born than you have already begun to die.!®°

220. What can all people do? – Praise and blame. This is the virtue of humans, this is the madness of humans.!86

221. Injustice is always being committed – says justice –
and
not only when you hurt yourselves but also when you help,
love,
and serve each other. Nothing is remedied by praise and
love,
they are harmful because they do not remedy anything.'®?
222. What do you know of the love that a lunatic has for
rea-
son, like the love someone burning with fever has for ice!!
®8

223. In science, in knowing, drives have become holy: “the
thirst for pleasures, the thirst for becoming, the thirst
for
power.” The humans who know have far surpassed themselves
in holiness.!®

224. I was in school: I lived for knowledge. There my soul
purified itself, all desires became holy. It is the
preschool: the
solitude of the one who knows. You should deal with humans
the way you deal with objects. your love should be above all
individual objects and individual humans.

190 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

225. The will to suffer: once in a while you must live in
the
world, you who create. You must a/most perish – and after-
wards
bless your labyrinth and your stray paths. Otherwise you
cannot
create, but only die off. You must have your triumphs and
your
downfalls. You must have your evils and once in a while take
them up again. You eternally returning ones, you yourselves
must make of yourselves a return.

226. Creating is redemption from suffering. But suffering is
necessary for those who create. Suffering is self-transform-
ation,

in every birth there is a death. We must be not only the
children,

but also the ones who give birth: as those who create.!°

227. We must want to pass away in order to be able to emerge
again – from one day to the next. Metamorphosis through a
hundred souls – let this be your life, your destiny:

And then finally: to want this entire sequence once again!

228. Look at him to see if he has a clear eye and a mouth
free

of contempt. Look at him to see if he walks like a dancer.!!?

229. Often you have to abandon everything, your woman, your land, your usefulness: you must tell the sun in your life

to stand still.!!??

230. Your life of pleasures is a kind of self-mortification: and

both are illnesses and degradations.'

231. We should serve those whose spirit, self-overcoming, and

invention of new projects will be expanded through your service: – in this way, as a servant, you will have been most useful to yourself.

232. Don't be angry at those who think in the way that perishing people tend to think: they are grasping at their straws

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of life and know little of life other than grasping and that it

makes little sense to do so: perishing people aren't worth much

– this is the kernel of their "wisdom"!4

233. You have not yet decided to live, but rather you are afraid

and tremble like children at the water they are supposed to dive into. And meanwhile your time slips away, and you search

for teachers who tell you: "be afraid and tremble at the ocean

called life" – and you call this teaching good and die early.

234. The value of life lies in value judgments: value judgments

are something created, not something taken, not something learned, not something experienced. What has been created must be destroyed to make room for the newly created: a value

judgment's ability to live includes its capacity to be destroyed.

The creator must always be a destroyer. Yet valuation itself cannot destroy itself: for this is life."

234. "Life is suffering?" – If you are right: well then, it is

your life that is suffering! – so make sure that you stop; make

sure that life, which is nothing but suffering, stops. Your morality is: "thou shalt kill thyself?" "thou shalt steal away."!°

235. And even those who turned their backs on life and found joy and peace in the process – – – they found it by creating an image of such a life, as ones who create! – – – as ones who create, you brought your suffering to an end! And in this

way loved your life!

236. You imagine that you are free from the maxims of those who know: but you are incapable of doing anything without grasping for our valuations, you helpless people! Much less ever creating! This delusion of being free is part of the happi-

ness of deprivation! A consolation for prisoners! A good deed on

behalf of those born blind!

192 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

237. Animals don't know anything about themselves, they don't even know anything about the world.!??

238. I am too full:!"® in this way I forget myself, and all things

are in me, and there is nothing more than all things. Where am I headed?

239. The tightly interwoven sensations that always return ("holding a time together in a relative sense") are regarded by us

as raw materials and realities: in the first instance, our bodies.

But "all the properties of these things consist of our sensations and representations."!??

241. What is to come is just as much a condition of what is as

of what has been. "What should be and what must be is the basis for what is."?°

242. Am I supposed to have created the whole universe? Was it the movement of my I that brought this about, just as it brought about the movement of a body? Am I merely a droplet of this force?

243. I comprehend only a being that is simultaneously one and

many, that changes and stays the same, that knows, feels, wills

– this being is my primordial fact.

244. Once when I wanted to find pleasure in truth, | inven-

ted
 lying and illusion – proximity and distance, what is past
 and
 what is to come, that which is perspectival. Then I projec-
 ted
 obscurity and deception into myself and made myself into
 something that deceived myself.?°!
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 not be loved. Humans are too imperfect a thing: love for hu-
 mans
 would kill me.?°
 246. I did not repudiate these humans that I loved: but
 rather
 the very thing that made me love them, that's what I
 repudiated.?03
 247. Look into the world as if time were missing: and all
 that
 is crooked will become straight for you.?°*
 yourself and to say to yourself: you should not be seeing
 blue!?!%
 249. Some want to throw dice and others want to count and
 calculate, and those over there want to see dancing: they
 call it
 science and it makes them sweat. But they are children who
 want to have their game – and truly, it is a kind of beauti-
 ful
 childishness, and some laughter would not hurt the game."
 250. All signs of the superhuman appear as illness or mad-
 ness
 in humans.?°"
 251. We must already be an ocean in order to absorb a filthy
 stream without getting filthy.?°8
 252. When I considered purpose, I also considered chance
 and folly.?°°
 253. You are too crude for me: it is impossible for minor
 expe-
 riences to be your downfall.?!°
 254. Your eye doesn't go blind at the point where it can no
 longer recognize things, but just at the point where your
 hon-
 esty ceases, that's where your eye sees nothing more."!!
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 255. What apes are to us, a laughing stock or a painful em-
 bar-
 rassment: so shall humans be to superhumans.?!?
 256. How would someone have to speak to you so that you

would understand! You must first get sick before you have ears
to hear.?!13

257. As soon as the will takes the stage, feeling experiences a
sense of liberation. For feeling suffers – and as soon as the
will takes the stage, feeling is suspended and does not suffer.

This is called freedom of the will.?!*

258. How heavy the world became for me then – like a creature that has lived in the sea and was now forced to crawl up
on land: now how is it supposed to drag its own body along!?
>

259. You should not live in places where you are forced to have
puny feelings. There is no worse way to waste your life than in
puny settings.

260. If you are too soft and squeamish to kill flies and mosquitoes,
then go into solitude and fresh air where there are no flies
and mosquitoes: and be solitude and fresh air yourselves!?!”
Your poor body – ignorance of the laws of nature.

261. Illness is a clumsy experiment at achieving good health:

our minds must come to the aid of nature.?!8
we are all stupid. Even stupidity goes by a nicer name: it calls
itself necessity. Let us definitely come to the aid of necessity!?!?

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263. What is it about the fact that as many people as possible
live as long as possible? Is their happiness a justification of all
existence? And not actually a despicable thing??”°
become the devil’s advocate, you must also be God’s advocate
with the devil.??!

265. Speech to the cliff I love that you do not speak. Your silence is dignified. (Perceiving everything in nature morally:

all value lies in that)???
Speech to a king.

266. The world stands there, finished – a golden bowl of goodness. But the creative spirit also still wants to create what is finished: so it invented time – and now the world spun apart and spins in great rings back into itself again, like the emergence of good through evil, like a mother giving birth to purposes out of chance.???

267. There are enough of these people who do not know anything better on earth than to lie with a woman. What do they know of happiness!??*

Invisible ties bind most tightly.

268. Whenever I honor a feeling, the feeling becomes infused with honor.

269. What use is your virtue if you have yet to experience the moment when you come to deeply despise what is human within you out of love for superhumans? And despise your virtue along with it?

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270. In the history of humankind, the moments of great contempt?" are the events: as the source of the great desire for superhumans. Don't let yourselves be fooled – hasn't there always been a desire to journey into the beyond or into nothingness or to become one with God? All these colorful phrases served to express how tired humans were of themselves – not of their suffering, but rather of their usual ways of feeling.

271. To await the hour of the great contempt: this is the commendation. The other hours exist merely for the sake of cultivating the Zast humans.

272. Thoughts are merely signs, as words are merely signs for thoughts.

273. Atone time the I was hidden in the herd: now the herd is still hidden in the I.??°

5 [2]?27

I teach you two things; you should overcome humans, and
you should know when you have overcome them: I teach you
war and victory. (Chap(ter))

5 B)"

It is cool, the meadow lies in shadow, the sun has departed.
Is it not absurd to live?

Wouldn't we have to have more reason in order to make
something reasonable out of life?

My brothers, forgive the soul of Zarathustra for the fact
that

it is evening.

star

Am I really rejecting your virtues? I am rejecting the
virtu-

ous among you.

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5 [5]?

I am explaining even your virtues by what is to come.

5 [6]

As soon as feeling grows and swells within the herd, feeling
comes closer to the herd.

First "for all" became sacred, then "for someone else" fi-
nally

"for my God." s [712

I love souls that squander: they do not give back and do not
even want thanks – because they keep giving gifts.

5 [8]

I teach you about the superhumans: where is my brother
who teaches them??? the great contempt?

5 [9]

They overturn icons??? and say: there is nothing exalted and
worthy of worship – because they themselves can create nei-
ther icon nor God.

Have mercy on them! Just listen to the contempt of their
rage against icons – the great contempt for themselves!

5 [10]?35 (chap(ter)) "the brotherhood of justifiers."

s ms

It is terrible to die of thirst in the middle of the ocean:
must

you then salt your wisdom so much that it doesn't taste like
pure water?

5 [2]?

Humankind is walking around pregnant, how quaint its
labor pains.

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5 3"

Our contempt for humans drove us beyond the stars and
allowed us to search around for a god.

5 1a)?"

The scholar should be a penitent of the mind

5 [15]?

They said "let us make ourselves dead to the world," they
sought their salvation beyond the stars, they did not find
news?! of the superhumans.

5 [16]?*?

Let your life be an experiment with a hundred permutations:
let your failures and successes be proof: and take care that
your

experiments and what you have proven become known.

5 17)*

I love those who justify the people of the future and redeem
the people of the past: even as they perish because of the
people

of the present.

I love those who make virtue into their duty and their doom.

I love those who do not spare a drop of spirit and who are
entirely the spirit of their virtue:

I love those who squander their souls, who do not want
thanks and do not give back because they are always giving
gifts.⁷⁴⁴

I love those who take upon themselves the injustice suffered
by those who cannot bear it?*

I love those who live to know and who want to know so that
the superhumans may live.

I love those who do not want to become dead to the world
and who do not seek their salvation beyond the stars: those
who have understood the news of the superhumans.

I love those whose souls are deep even when wounded and
who can perish as a result of one minor experience.⁷⁴⁵

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I love those who are so full that they forget themselves,
and

all things are in them: but they will perish.

I love those whose minds are free just as their hearts are
free: and let their heads be merely the entrails of their
hearts.

I love those who are so compassionate that they make
hard-heartedness into their virtue and their god."

I love those who strew golden words before their deeds and
still always deliver more than they promise.

I love those who are ashamed when the dice always fall
their way and who ask themselves: am I then a cheater?

I love those who forgive their opponents not only their failures but also their victories."

I love those who chastise their god because they love their god.

I love those who do not expect rewards from their virtue, but rather punishment and downfall.

I love those who see the suffering god hidden in their neighbors and who are ashamed of the animal that was visible in their neighbors.?"

5 [18]?

You should not want to have too many virtues. One virtue is already a lot of virtue: and we must be rich enough even for just a single virtue. You should perish so that it may live.

5 [19]?!

I entreat you, my brothers, remain true to the earth and don't believe those who speak to you of hopes beyond this earth: they are poisoners and despisers of life: whether they

know it or not, they are the ones who are dying off and have poisoned themselves.

At one time, sacrilege against God was the greatest sacrilege: but God died, and then even the people committing sacrilege died with him. Sacrilege against the earth is now the

most terrible thing, and reverence for the entrails of unexplorable

things more than for the meaning of the earth.

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5 [20]?

Let your life be an experiment with a hundred permutations: let your successes and failures be proof; and take care that your

experiments and what you have proven become known.

5 [21]25%

There are libertines of the mind: there are penitents of the mind. 5 [22]255

The eye doesn't go blind at the point where it can no longer distinguish things, but rather at the point where your honesty

ceases, that is where the eye sees nothing more.

5 [23]°

Some want to throw dice and others want to count and calculate, and those over there want to see dancing: they call it

science and it makes them sweat

But they are children who want to have their game – and truly, it is beautiful infantile nonsense, and a bit of laughter

would make the faces of the players more lovable.

5 [24]

When you consider purpose, you must also consider chance and folly. 5 [25°

Objections, mistrust, adultery are signs of a healthy spirit.

Everything unconditional reveals?' a sick person.

5 [26]2°

Once, when I wanted to find pleasure in truth, that's when I invented lying and illusion, proximity and distance, what is

past and what is to come; then I internalized deceit and twilight.

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5 27)?

I was in the desert, I lived merely as one who knows. The soul of one who knows purified itself, and all desires and the

thirst for power became sacred to that person. As one who knows I ascended far above and beyond myself in sanctity and virtue.

5 [28]?%2

Human existence is uncanny and still without meaning: a clown? can bring about its doom.

For what purpose does this person live? For what purpose does that person die? No one can know, because there is no for-what-purpose in these matters.

Formerly, when death approached, people used to lift up a hand and say, "a gift from above."

This giver did not exist at all, a roof tile was the gift: in

death, ignorance was as far as reason went.

I want to teach humans the meaning of their existence: which is the superhumans.

5 [29]?°®

Let yourself be schooled by love for things and justice for things. 5 [30]?%

You shroud your souls: nakedness would be scandalous for your souls. Oh when will you learn why gods are naked! They have nothing to be ashamed of. They are more powerful naked!

The body is something evil, beauty is the work of the devil;

emaciated, ghastly, starving, black, dirty, that's how the
body
should look
Sacrilege against the body is for me a sacrilege against the
earth and against the meaning of the earth. Pity those un-
happy
people for whom the body seems evil and beauty diabolical!
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5 [31]
Your body and your embodied self stand behind your
thoughts and feelings: the terra incognita.?°° What is the
pur-
pose of you having these thoughts and these feelings? Your
embodied self wants to do something with them.
5 [132]?
The asceticism of the mind (addressed to the most intellec-
tual)
the friend (the ideal company)
solitude
the body philosophizes
the one who creates
danger in the sermon on suffering
Against the devaluation of life
in knowledge, the drives are justified
the goal of humankind has been missing up until now
justification of the entire past
the one who communicates as fragment
the one who loves as fragment
the one who knows as fragment
not to value contemporary culture too highly!
for once, the passions as good health
chastity
teaching peace and inner effort. Against "effort."
the criminal.
retribution
moral outrage and forgiveness.
the one who praises
women
means of self-overcoming
the scientific ones
death
the recurrence
herd and |
slowly accumulating fame
critique of morality and its meaning
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judgment in pleasure
contradiction in your ideals
we must also want our counterpart, the Pharisee.
the hidden human
the last human
speech to a king.
superhumans
invention of festivals
penitents of the mind – as purifiers of their affects
great decision between death and life?°®
actors and those who create.
the new art form as 1000 ways to live (independence first! a
thought that compels those who follow it freely)
life an experiment by those who know
to ennoble what is common, nearest, earthly! (cuisine diet)
solitude and life – sleep and waking (life as will to suffer
(– to create –)
the supreme knowledge: the new evaluator.
slowly accumulating fame
critique of morality and its meaning: we want to lift our-
selves above praise and blame!
madness as prefiguring.
retribution – you want compensation?
without a homeland.
to turn humility into pride.
new wars.

whether there have already been superhumans

5 [33]

It is not enough to make amends for something: we must
also remake ourselves, be good to ourselves again, e.g., by
means of some small superfluous mischief or good deed.
Before we can forgive, we must first experience being
wronged.

And with more profound individuals all experiences last a
long
time.?"

204 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

It is easier to forgive our enemies than our friends.
I should forgive? But I don't blame you for the same reasons
you blame yourself: how could I then forgive?
Not that you lied to me, but rather that I no longer be-
lieved
you, this is what has shaken me.

We take the bitterness that we feel toward people and use it
to justify our moral outrage – and admire ourselves in the
process; and we justify forgiveness through the fading of

our

hatred – and admire ourselves once again.?”!

He wronged me, this is bad. But that he now wants to go so far as to beg my pardon, this is worse, this drives me crazy.?’?

Beware of insulting a hermit! He never forgives! A hermit is like a deep well – it is easy to toss a stone into it. But how do

you propose to retrieve it once it has reached the bottom??”?

5 [34]

All goals have been destroyed: value judgments are turning against themselves,

those who follow their heart are called good but also

those who are merely alert to their duty

unassuming, forgiving people are called good, but also

brave unbending austere people.

those who make no demands on themselves are called

good, but also heroes of self-overcoming

unconditional friends of truth are called good, but also

pious people, the glorifiers of things

those who obey themselves are called good, but also pious people

noble, genteel people are called good, but also those who do not despise and condescend

good-natured people who avoid battle are called good,

but also those who lust for battle and victory

those who always want to be first are called good, but

also those who never want to take advantage of anyone.

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5 Bs]?”

I do not understand why we find it necessary to slander others. If we want to hurt people, we only need to say something true about them.

We always know too much about everyone.

We praise only what appeals to our taste i.e., we praise only

our own taste.

the most inspired passion

to make a virtue out of antipathy for someone

In the flam(es) of jea(lousy) we turn the poisonous stinger against ourselves, like a scorpion – yet without (its) success

When I notice that people are lying to me, I don't complain that they are lying to me, but rather that they are lying at all.

[6 = M III 3b. Winter 1882-1883]

6 [a] Asceticism: to cultivate only reason
to admit to oneself the small joys that knowledge
brings – to keep all others
away.

cruelty in admitting to ourselves the dirty
emergence of all supreme things
attempt to look away from human beings and to
fix them as points in becoming – not to model
everything on them.
on behalf of little certain hard truths – military
discipline simplicity
mocking the blissful effect of “truths,” likewise
mocking the beautiful form. Religion morality
and art concerning the surface of things
metaphysics as related to the belief in spirits and
ghosts: also to poor interpretation
the perspective of happiness as harmful to science
where does the value of metaphysics come from?
From errors and passions.

Not to allow ourselves to become dependent upon
the most uncertain things
to admit to ourselves the weakness of our
reasoning: dreams.

6 WINTER 1882-1883 207

a strong feeling proves nothing about the truth of
what is believed.

Attempt to look at things in such a way that
substance and freedom of the will are errors: even
the I regarded as having become. The world as
error.

Mistrust of the metaphysical world because of the
difficulty of the problems.

All tranquility ceases with the belief in eternal
basic truths, we no longer care about anything
beyond our future because by then other things
will become necessary.

Era of comparison: a choice from among the
various ethics. Downfall of lowly ethics.

Cult of error: it made humans so sensitive, deep,
inventive. The world as error is so rich in
meaning and full of wonder.

we are, from beginning to end, illogical and
unjust beings – there is no life without this.
all initial approaches to the value of life false.
Final purposelessness. Squandering.

universally successful renunciation: always to know better, the only consolation to float above evaluations.

Result: I don't need to believe in anything

Things are unknowable.

I don't need to suffer on account of my injustice.

despair purged through skepticism

I acquired the right to create

the right to call things good

the right not to make connections to the past

finally: within all the activity of the drives I discovered

living morality, driving force. I had only imagined

that I was beyond good and evil.

208 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Freethinking was itself a moral act

1) as honesty 2) as bravery 3) as justice 4) as love

I held myself apart as one who posits values

I did nothing other than criticize the practice of morality up

until now. The establishment of moral judgments is itself a piece of this practice.

the determination of purposes as a condition of existence,

as a condition for one? existence merging into another.

herd – individual.

6 [2]4

1. Asceticism – attempt to live without morality.

2. Result: we ourselves have practiced

morality, continued to practice it –

the life within us required it of us.

Everything that 3. The one who creates and the

happens does not one who posits values. Herd

correspond to the and individual.

judgment of value. 4. Attempt at a standpoint

beyond good and evil.

6 [3]

Asceticism: attempt to liberate ourselves from morality

Change, indeed, opposition of moral judgments (no

eternal norm)

there have never ever been any moral actions: if they are characterized as free and as unegoistic.

what we take to be evil (injustice) is a condition for existing.

6 WINTER 1882-1883 209

in critiquing our best actions, we find it absolutely necessary

to use elements that belong to evil.

all moral systems have been refuted: and in any case their value is dependent upon the truth of their last assertions: these assertions are uncertain.

A multitude of opposing moral systems are contained in our valuations themselves.

(our judgments underlying the feelings are contradictory.)

In the end there is no longer any goal: morality is no longer

the way to heaven: no longer even the way to heaven on earth (agony of pangs of conscience) Morality no longer stands or falls with states and peoples.

Terrifying look back at the agony of humankind. They were close to renouncing? life because of their moral dissatisfaction.

6 [4]

1) Ascetic attempt to liberate ourselves from morality: why?

initially, as practical consequence: a soldier's poverty, nearness of death. Freethinker.

2) But now we recognize freethinking itself as morality. In what way.

All feelings are morally tinged. What we did was a therapy, a means to /ife. Morality appeared as a condition of existence.

3) the new freer view of morality as a condition of existence in life and progress in life.

Herd – evolution of the I. No retribution etc.

4) Attempt at a beyond good and evil.

[7 = M III 4b. Spring-Summer 1883]

7 W

Concerning the introduction.

Absolute honesty – missing up to now in moralists. Every character weakness will announce itself in the course of the investigation.

Thereafter historical meaning.

Bravely resisting our own inclination to make value judgments.

Ancient goal: the breeding of superior humans, using the masses as a means of doing so.

Concerning the Plan.

Every objective obligation is lacking. Universal agreement a principle hostile to life.

There are commands from individuals: an unconscious form of slavery

honesty requires that whatever we do for the sake of utility is also designated as such.

Motives for honesty etc. are found in the impulses of the powerful: the emancipation from morality also spreads within the same sphere.

To turn irresponsibility into something positive: we want to make our image of human beings prevail. Because we can! – is the point! Anyone who feels oppressed belongs in the inferior

order. There must be “slaves.”

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Up to now we overlooked the creative aspect of individuality: we noticed only criminals etc. we overlooked arch-criminals Homer Michelangelo.

Greatest possible diversity of individuals! Let the struggle begin!

We want to move toward an ethics: and since we do not believe that we can find our way to it from egoism, we flee toward authority, toward tradition.

ethical taste is a thing without basis – but it emerged at one

time as compulsion, as a result of other drives which demanded a

particular judgment and valuation.

Where we no longer know how to trace our feelings back to their origins due to the complexity of their emergence, we posit

them as something different: this is how aesthetic ethical moral

metaphysical drives are to be understood.

We perceive a name and think that it corresponds to something new.

NB. The moralistic) way of thinking accords with our behavior but does not guide it!

When there is no drive to obey, then a “thou shalt” has no meaning.

Given the way we are – we then become resistant to a “thou shalt.” Our morality has to mean “I will this.”

7 l]

In fact, the egoism of the individual reaches as far as it can

and as far as its strength permits –: it is nonsense to fear the

consequences of the egoist(ic) principle?” No one is constrained by principles!

7B1

It would be very superficial to write without asking how long

everything that is being written today will endure!

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7 1]

The confidence with which we act is completely unrelated to the goodness of our motives for acting in this or that way!

765

from Socrates onward, virtue without shame (in competition) and, as a subject of cleverness, virtue has no need of shame! A

kind of self-abasement of virtue –

7 [6]

Critique of “good people,” indeed of the best people! Skepticism

very justified!

My entire approach doesn’t involve morality– what was formerly consciousness of sin, I also direct these things against

the intellect, virtue, happiness, human strength.

On the basis of essentially extramoral considerations, I came

to consider morality from a distance.

To discern the conditions under which future humans will live – because such discernment and anticipation have the force of a motive: the future, as something that we will, acts

upon our now.

The immorality of our age at its best (e.g., the lack of reverence

in regard to nature)

7 [7]

Speeches to My Friends.

I have always made an effort to prove to myself the innocence of becoming:* and probably I wanted to attain in this way the feeling of complete “irresponsibility” – to make myself independent of praise and blame, of all todays and tradi-

tions: in order to pursue goals that concern the future of humankind.

The first solution for me was the aesthetic justification of existence.

However: “justifying” should not itself be necessary!

Morality belongs to the realm of appearance.

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The second solution for me was the objective lack of value of

all concepts of guilt and the insight into the subjective, neces-

sarily unjust and illogical nature of all life.

The third solution for me was the denial of all purposes and the insight into the unknowability of causalities.

redemption through illusion: the principium individu-

ationis,' along with all morality, a redemptive vision for the individual.

Morality a means of remaining within individuation and of not being sucked back into primordial suffering.

art as the "genuinely metaphysical activity of human beings."

6

that "at the foundation of things, in spite of all the changing appearances, life is indestructibly powerful and pleas-

ur-

able" p. 54.' as tragedy's consolation.

Art saves him (from denying the will): and through art life saves him for itself.

A protest against pessimism: from the standpoint of the Greeks. The Greek, "deeply sensitive and singularly capable of

the most tender and the most severe suffering"

Music as by far the most vital art form.

The task of music in an age analyzed to death, an age that is

tired of thinking:

p. 82 Science, led ever again to its limits, must be transformed

into art – that which leads it is the illusion that it could cor-

rect existence.®

Socrates relieved of his fear of death through knowledge and reasons.

the determination of science, to make existence appear intelligible and thereby justified: and when the reasons prove insuf-

ficient, myth too must be made to serve – it is fundamentally

intended for this!

Were that sum of force not applied toward knowledge, but

rather toward the practical aims of a people and of human beings, the desire for life would be so weakened that an ethic

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arising out of compassion could emerge (The Indic peoples too weak and passive even in their compassion)
tragic knowledge needs art "which stares into the inscrutable"?

Art represented as dependent upon the development of knowledge: it bursts forth wherever knowledge devours itself.

We should seek pleasure not in appearances, but behind them.

p- 92 Quintessence.

p. 102. the self-destruction of knowledge and the insight into

its ultimate limits was what excited me about Kant and Schopenhauer. From this dissatisfaction I came to believe in art."

I thought that a new age had arrived for art. I experienced the outcome of philosophy as a tragic event: how to endure it!

W (agner) seemed to me a means of alienating the G(ermans) from Christianity

his old and tired work, Parsifal, doesn't refute this either,

even less his blindly inflamed admirers with their skinned knees and brains.

Belief in the rebirth of the Greek world p. 117.)

"another being and a higher pleasure, for which the battling hero is prepared not through his victories, but through his downfall" p. 120."

"Only a horizon rearranged by myth culminates in an entire cultural movement toward unity" p. 132.4

p. 136 antichristian – in this sense,"

" "

p. 142 " German hope

10

7 [8]

The entire 18th century held Gothic architecture in the deepest contempt Lecky I 199.7

This century had its own taste. The Milan Cathedral as object of derision.

Our century must have recovered many of those feelings from which those churches emerged –

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The misidentification of Homer cf. in — — —
Winckelmann's critical evaluation of Laocoén.'®

7 [9]

Compassion. Initially reproduction of another's pain. Now
a reaction to it must follow
either a powerful purging from the senses, fleeing from it
(as
at the sight of a disgusting wound
or positive pushing aside and elimination of what hurts us,
in other words, an intervention in the sphere of the suffer-
ers,
interpreted by them as help, etc.
We are outraged by each act of suffering, when it is sense-
less,
"undeserved" (our custom of blaming and punishing functions
here as a wounded drive: the image of the sufferer" is an
assault
on the foundations of this drive) We react to this outrage
with
"help" etc.

Thereafter: — we shiver, we ourselves feel the danger, inse-
curity sudden misfortune "it's unbelievable!" — our sense of
harmony and logic is outraged.
where we feel that we can help, our feeling of power
awakens,
hence the zeal for duty, the excitement, the heroism while
res-
cuing victims; the pleasure at the opportunity to be brave
etc.
Love, tenderness are not necessary in such situations!

7 [20]

Hartmann" p. 776. the sovereignty of the individual, accord-
ing
to him, merges with the egoistic attention to prudence that
puts
limits on choice! This is typical!

7 (i

Our neighbors as our progeny
having given them the traits to which our drives react. The
whole
image, a progeny that is useful to us: that is beneficial to
us, harm-
ful etc. is swept away — for the purpose of assimilation or
flight.

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What then is "loving thy neighbor"?

Our neighbors are in themselves unknowable, except by inference in relation to us, and this according to the subtlety

or crudity of our observations: our overhastiness in deciding

(it's a matter of fear or longing) etc.

We battle what seems harmful to us in our enemies: whatever hinders our growth, our survival, what poisons our air: hence we battle our drives of mistrust, of tension – i.e., one

kind of drive pushes aside another.

7 [12]

The Jews corrupted by the Egyptian captivity.

7 [3]

Architecture: to bring what is distant nearer (St. Peter's Basilica)

another principle: the greatest possible striving for the distant.

7 [14]

We hate those people most who seduce us back into feelings that we have conquered with the greatest effort: those who betray us to our enemies after our triumph: this is how it is for

those like us who are seduced into revenge even after we have

forgiven someone.

7[t]

our conscience adapts (itself) to the environment in which we live; inasmuch as drives like fear, skepticism, reticence,

stealth etc. are generated by the feeling that our valuations are

not in agreement: these drives gradually immediately discharge

themselves at the time of our impulses and transform our con-

science into an evil conscience.”!

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7 [16]

Wagner received many favors from his contemporaries: but he was of the opinion that fundamental injustice toward bene-

factors was part of a “grand style”: he was always living as an

actor and under delusions of cultural sophistication, as actors

typically do. I myself have been perhaps his most generous benefactor. It is possible that in this case the image will outlive

the man on which it is modeled: this has to do with the fact that there is still plenty of room in my image for a host of real

Wagners: and above all for those much more richly gifted and more single-minded in purpose.

7 [17]

Those who live among Germans should count themselves lucky if they find a single individual who keeps a distance from that idealistic self-delusion and color-blindness that the

Germans adore and revere almost as virtue itself. (The French

with their Montaigne La Rochefoucauld Pascal Chamfort Stendhal are a much purer intellectual nation) This was my joy

when I got to know Rée:"" he spoke of morality only to the extent that he knew it and without conjuring up something based on his moral drives. To be sure: he didn't know much about it and even this was based only on hearsay: and in the end he thought that morality itself was hearsay.

7 8]

Since Kant, all talk of art, beauty, knowledge, wisdom has been mangled and muddled by the concept of "disinterest." What strikes me as beautiful (from the viewpoint of history): that which becomes visible about the most-admired people of an era, as an expression of what most deserves admiration.

7 9]

It was Helvétius's accomplishment, a matter of fortitude, to take pleasure (interest?) seriously (just as Socrates did with utility):

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just like Epicurus (as opposed to taking pleasure in the paradox-

ical, like Mandeville): and to say plaisir, as Stendhal wished,

was perhaps already too damaging to Helvétius (given the moral

taste out of which he himself grew)

7 [20]

Just as optics limps along behind sight, so, too, moral theory?

behind morality.

Individual observations are by far the most valuable thing. A mor(al) theory of fundamental error is most often the origin of great philosophical systems: something must be proved which agrees with the praxis of the philosopher (e.g. Spinoza) (Schopenhauer the exception – noblesse*® therein)
7 (aa)

My demand: to produce beings who stand sublimely above the entire species "human being": and who sacrifice themselves and "their neighbors" for this goal.

Morality up to now has had its boundaries dictated by the species: all moralities up to now were useful for establishing

first and foremost the unconditional stability of the species:

when this has been achieved, the goal can be set higher.

The one movement is unconditional: the leveling of humankind, giant ant hills etc. (Dühring to be characterized as extraordinarily impoverished and typically narrow, despite his

lofty words)

The other movement: my movement: is conversely the intensification of all oppositions and divisions, elimination of equality, the creation of the superpowerful.?7

The former generates last humans. My movement, superhumans. The goal is not at all to conceive of the latter as the masters

of the former: but rather: the two species should exist along-

side one another – as segregated as possible; the one, like the

Epicurean gods, having no concern for the other.

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Principles: there have never been any moral actions. And every morality is impossible: just like every moral action. But the history of what has been accepted up to now as moral action: and the true meaning of the acceptance. And the

history of the emergence of this acceptance.

They all proceed from the belief that morality itself is there,

at least as a conscious measure (as with Kant), that we know what good and evil are.

The essential unknowability.

Something is necessarily achieved: but already knowledge of it is impossible, therefore even foreknowledge of it!

The most important standpoint: to attain the innocence of

becoming, in that purpose is excluded. Necessity, causality
 – all
 gone! And always to brand as mendacity any mention of “pur-
 pose” wherever a necessary result appears! History can never
 prove “purpose”: for, one thing is clear, that what peoples
 and
 individuals have wanted has always been essentially differ-
 ent
 from what has been achieved – in short, that everything that
 has been achieved is absolutely incongruent with what has
 been
 wanted (e.g., chewing as “intention” and “action”)
 History of “intentions” is something other than history of
 “facts”: – in morality. It is the crudest form of prejudice
 to see
 nothing more than what is congruent with its intended pur-
 pose. This
 attention to purpose is a sign of a low level of intellect –
 everything
 essential, the action itself and the result are overlooked!
 #b]?
 While wandering through the many subtler and cruder
 moralities, I found certain traits in a consistent pattern,
 always
 recurring with each other and connected to each other: so
 that
 finally two basic types were revealed to me: there is mas-
 ter-
 morality and slave-morality. I would add that, in times of
 higher culture, attempts at mediating between both moralit-
 ies
 come to light, even more frequently their intermingling, in-
 deed
 occasionally a bitter coexistence – even in the same person,
 within a single soul.

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First question: where did moral value judgments emerge? In
 general, among aristocrats, among a ruling kind that becomes
 conscious of how it differs from the ruled.
 In general, making moral value judgments means that a
 superior kind of human being becomes conscious of its su-
 peri-
 ority to a lower kind.
 The need to form a superior kind of human being initially
 existed in relation to the subjugated, then in relation to
 virtue.

In the first case, the exceptional, unique, noble, distinguishing qualities are emphasized, in the second case, the difficulty in attaining and maintaining a noble type, in short, in working toward virtue.

Second question. What follows in general from the fact that the rulers are the ones who determine the concept "good"? There are in fact a number of traits that return in drastically

differing moralities: the reason for this lies in the fact that the

traits of the powerful are contained in these moralities.

An immoral person is in general a contemptible person (ot an "evil" person).

This extends as far as the ultimate consequence: those who, like me, devalue moral value judgments by comparing them to each other, want to distinguish themselves as superior human beings from those who can bear to live according to conventional value judgments.

The sublime loftier states are the ones that are called "good":??

Contempt for those who are cowardly, anxious

Contempt for those who think of strict utility, for petty people

Contempt for the mistrustful, who want to have oaths

Contempt for the poor, for beggars, self-denigrators, slave- and dog-like people, who let themselves be mistreated.

By contrast, all honor to feelings of fullness and of overflowing: rich enough to help the unfortunate,

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All honor to those who have control over themselves, who understand when to speak and when to be silent, who understand when to command and when to obey

All honor to wisdom that knows how to keep long-term utility in mind and that can stand by its long-term decisions

All honor to those who don't want to be liked, because they like themselves: the proud.

Reverence for elders

for ancestors

reverence for women? is modern:?! respect for the e/derly is somewhat lacking.

þúveoða "defense" as a part of revenge.??

capacity for long-term gratitude and revenge.

Restitution as a delusion of justice. —
 anyone indifferent to a grave personal offense is contemptible . . . but: "the best man is the one who can bear the most
 insults" Menander.??
 but not inclined to bear a grudge! —
 complete distinction between judging actions directed at equals and actions directed at beings of lesser rank.
 the friend
 The enemy is not regarded as contemptible: hence evil actions
 have a different value than the enemy's actions.
 Inasmuch as enmity is necessary, the point of it must be kept
 in mind, thus in a certain sense cultivated.
 (like deception among the Spartans)
 'hardness of feeling, cruelty, etc.
 Enemies are needed as lightning rods for affects like jealousy, contentiousness — in order to be a good friend.
 the powerful ones judge: anyone who harms me is harmful by nature. They are the supreme determiners of value.
 What would the commonalities in morality have to look like when the weak, the subjugated and the oppressed moralize? When those who are victimized, oppressed, suffering, unfree, unsure of themselves, exhausted, moralize: what will be the
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 commonalities in their moral distinctions? Probably a suspicion will be expressed; perhaps a condemnation of humans along with their situation.
 A denigrating view of the virtues of the more powerful: subtle skepticism and mistrust of everything "good" will be honored there and also a decrease in the happiness of the powerful and a diminishment of life.
 Foregrounding of the qualities by means of which those who suffer can make their lives easier: renown of compassion,
 but for different reasons than those given when the powerful celebrate it (utility is the reason)
 Renown of humility and refinement of this viewpoint through universal subjugation to the laws of existence: prediction for "unfreedom of the will"³⁴— human beings dependent through and through.
 There is a kind of revenge in the foregrounding of competing virtues: thus abstinence, capricious mortification,

solitude,
intellectual poverty are praised: and the future is associated
with apathy.

In Europe this entire moral pivot is Jewish.

Granted, this kind of mentality gradually achieves dominance and people who have it become the rulers: thus the result

is a monstrous moral mendacity (or shamelessness).

(the plebeian quality in the Greek moralists Socrates) .

This happened among the European clergy. In English utilitarianism, in Kant, Schopenhauer.

(value of the French: their tact in regard to shame)

Now a second twist is possible: that of shamelessness: the universal pleasure in the human beast, in the fact that there

are illusions

Among the ruled, evil becomes "bad."

Imagining a grand revenge (Tertullian)?%?°

7 [23]

That which is logical, time, space would have to be produced by us: nonsense! When the mind obeys its own laws, this is

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because they are actually true, true in themselves! That we believe in

this truth, absolutely, is the consequence of the abnormal people

dying out: an error with respect to these truths avenges itself."

7 [24]

Since Rée proceeds from the principle that good is solely what people do not do for their own sake: then when he wants to give society the right to make use of the maxim "the end justifies the means," he has, in a most laughable fashion, provided the rope for his own hanging.® This is because, with all

its punishment of criminals, society seeks its own preservation and advantage – there is no doubt about this. Consequently, there is nothing good, nothing holy about society's end: consequently, its end cannot justify its evil means.

Anyone who remains fixated on "good" and "evil" cannot punish: the same is true of anyone who believes in "deserved"

and "undeserved": against all of this, absolute causality must be established. – Only when power is seized by a superior kind of human being to oppress a lesser kind, to keep it reined in, in any case to oppose it on all fronts: do I understand everything having to do with "punishing." It is oppression – using the word justice is Phariseism. I wouldn't know from where to derive the notion that the stronger, the superior are allowed to use their power against the lesser: much less why they should nor be allowed to. In any place where that which is superior is not that which is more powerful, something is lacking precisely in that which is superior: it is only a fragment and a mere shadow.
7 bs]?

Pain and pleasure are only accompanying phenomena. Hunger does not have as its goal satisfying the appetite: but rather, the process, the distinguishing feature of that which we call hunger, is in no way a drive or a state of feeling: it is a chemical state in which the affinity for other things is perhaps greater.

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How impoverished is our insight into everything that is real if we are bound by pleasure and displeasure as the only language for it!

"Drive" is only a translation from the language of nonfeeling into the language of feeling:

"Will": this is what is communicated to our feelings as a result of that process – in other words already an effect, and not the beginning and cause.

Our speech is a mishmash of two spheres.

"End and means" – is only taken from the language of feeling.

Thus every single function goes its own way. but how little of

it we notice! – And still we think that we can explain our actions with “ends,” with striving for bliss!

7 126]°

Not “happiness follows virtue” – but rather the more powerful people initially determine their state of happiness as virtue.

Evil actions are the province of the powerful and the virtuous: bad base actions are the province of the subjugated. The most powerful people have to be the most evil, inasmuch as they force their ideals on all people in opposition to all those

people’s ideals and reshape these ideals in their image – the ones who create.

Evil means here: hard-hearted painful imposed

7 7]

Humans like Napoleon must continually return and reinforce faith in the self-glorification of the individual: yet he himself was

corrupted by the means he had to employ and lost the noblesse

of character. In establishing himself among a different kind of

human being, he could have used other means, and so it would not have been necessary that a Caesar would have had to become

a bad person.

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7 [28]

To help the common masses achieve a ruling position is clearly the only means of ennobling their kind: but hope-fully

not in their struggle for domination, but rather once they have

begun to rule. Instead, the struggle unleashes their most profound baseness.

Hence the Jews ruling for a while is the only means of ennobling them.

7 [29]

“We act according to ‘ends’” (according to representations that

accompany expected pleasurable feelings) – or so we say. In truth,

something completely different, unconscious and unknowable, is

happening: with the phrase "ends and means," we fix our gaze on the tiniest part of what happens – and we initially interpret even that as ends and means.

We speak as if feelings were causes and could be causes in the realm of nonfeeling people.

The images and reflexes of a process are understood and interpreted by us as the process itself.

This is our greatest error, to think that the reality of a process is proved through pleasure and pain, to think that here everything is most real.

Feelings as accompanying phenomena can certainly teach us the sequence of processes of which they are images: but not

the causality of this sequence.

2»

7 [30]

Those who are useful to others, why should they be better than when they are useful to themselves? But only when the utility they provide others is superior in an absolute sense to

the utility they provide themselves. If others are worth less,

then the useful act rightly when they are useful to themselves,

even at the expense of others.

All this chatter about "utility" already presupposes that what

is useful to people has been defined: in other words, useful for

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what! i.e., the people's purposes are already taken for granted.

Survival, making people happy, etc., if these are purposes: but

then there are also circumstances under which their opposites

are the higher purposes, e.g., as with a pessimistic view of life

and suffering.

Thus, a belief is already presupposed – when praising those who are not self-interested: that the ego does not deserve to

take precedence over the ego of another? Yet this is contradicted by the higher appraisal of those who are not self-interested:

indeed, they are certainly assumed to be a rarer type. For what reason, then, should the rarer superior people lose sight of themselves? – They certainly shouldn't, it is stupid, but they do it: and others profit by it and are grateful to them for it: they praise them. – Thus do egoistic people praise those who are unegoistic, because they are stupid enough to put their advantage ahead of their own advantage: because they act as egoistic people would not – but to their benefit.

7 [31]

According to Spinoza: “insofar as humans make use of reason, they consider useful only that which leads to knowing?

®

7 [32]

The supreme ruler and the slave (the former elevated into a god, the latter sinking by the same measure)

7 [33]*

That in all “sense-impressions” we are not only passive but rather very active, choosing, connecting, completing, interpreting – it has to do with sustenance, as with a cell: with assimilation and adjustment of what is disparate.

7 [34]

the limited means of knowledge “he is calmed, subdued, renouncing, patient, collected” the more proximate means of
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knowledge: study of the Vedas, sacrifice, alms, penitence, fast-

ing – a means of achieving knowledge.

7 [35]

Spinoza took revenge on Jewish law through his ethics: “individuals can do what they want”:*° similar to Paul.

7 B”

In repudiating all eudaimonism, Kant sought the most extreme expression of moral pride. absolute obedience: the ideal

of a subjugated and oppressed person who assigns all value wher-

ever the obedient have the best training – and no “pleasure,”

no matter what!

7 [37]

“Illusions are necessary, not only for happiness, but also for

the preservation and enhancement of humans: in particular, no action at all is possible without illusion. Even each step

forward in knowledge is not possible except through illusion:

consequently, the source of the illusion must be maintained if

we want to know, behave correctly and grow” – that’s what I once thought.

If there were an absolute morality, it would demand that the truth be followed unconditionally. consequently, that J and human beings would perish as a result. – This my interest in destroying morality. In order to be able to live and to become

superior– in order to satisfy the will to power, every absolute

command ment would have to be abolished. For the most powerful

human beings, even lying is an acceptable means when creating:

this is exactly how nature works.

7 [38]

The morality of prudence developed in oppressed natures: to the point that the crime that remains concealed is regarded as

virtuous and has beneficial consequences for the perpetrator.

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The extreme pursuit of pleasure as a goal of morality is already

characteristic of oppressed and suffering natures. With the powerful, things are appraised according to the pleasures of the moment: here /ofty feelings become intellectual.

Eudaimonism hedonism utilitarianism as signs of unfreedom, just like every prudential morality.”

Heroism as sign of freedom. “Hints of a heroic philosophy.”*°

Heroism includes, then, even a heartfelt involvement in the trivial, the idyllic.

7 [39]

We don't have to look for morals (even less, morality!) in those who write about morals, the vast majority of moral theorists are oppressed suffering impotent vengeful – they are drawn to a little happiness: sick people who think that convalescence is everything,
7 [40]

A very noble way of thinking shines forth in La Rochefoucauld, characteristic of the society of that time: he himself is a disappointed idealist who under the inspiration of Christianity seeks out nasty names for the impulses of his time.
7 [41]

The moral complexity of the soul throughout Christianity and the time of chivalry is suited to the character of Louis XIV and his era: the Greeks (Homer) seem too simple and straightforward, even with respect to their souls.
7 [42]

With freedom of trade, groups of similar people can band together and establish associations in common. Overcoming of nations.

Predators and the primeval forest show that evil can be quite

healthy and helps to build magnificent bodies. If predatory
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species of animals were plagued by inner struggles, they would

long ago have atrophied and degenerated.

Dogs (who whine and whimper so much) are degenerate predators, just like cats. Huge numbers of good-hearted oppressed

people show that good-heartedness is accompanied by a decline in

vitality: fearful feelings predominate! and control the organism.

Therefore we do not have to foreground the kind of evil that shows up as overly refined and stimulating, as a result of physical

degeneration (cruelty-induced-lust etc.) and the moral mindlessness that comes with moral insanity)?!

To observe goodness, how it shows up as a sign of degeneration – as religious lunacy e.g., as philanthropy etc.: wherever

there is a decline in healthy egoism and a pursuit of apathy or asceticism. The "saint" as ideal of the atrophied body, even the

entire Brahmin-philosophy a sign of degeneration.

a) the superior kind: — — —

b) the inferior kind: — — —

c) the degenerates: their "good" their "evil."

7 [43]

"No one wants her as a gift: so she needs to sell herself!"

— I said

7 [44]

I consider Greek morality to be the supreme morality up to now; what this consideration shows me is that its bodily expression made (it) the supreme morality up to now.

Yet by that I mean the actual people's morality — not the one

espoused by the philosophers: the decline of morals begins with

Socrates: there are exclusively one-sided elements in the different

systems that in earlier times were parts of a whole — it is

the disintegrated older ideal. In addition there is the predominantly

plebeian character, there are people without power, marginalized, oppressed etc.

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In more recent times the Italian Renaissance brought human beings to their highest level: "the Florentine? — for similar

reasons. Isolated conditions are also evident there alongside

perfect and whole human beings, like fragments: e.g., "the tyrant" is such a fragment: the art aficionado.

Perhaps the Provencal had already achieved such an apogee in Europe — very rich, multifaceted, and yet selfpossessed human beings, who were not ashamed of their drives.

7 [45]

Luther's kind of enmity betrays his peasant heritage and baseness, his lack of nobility.

Napoleon corrupted in the struggle for power, like Bismarck.

I am hoping for puny "tyrants" in the coming century.'

7 [46]

From offstage Stendhal cites as a proverb: "Telle trouve a

se

vendre, qui nett pas trouvé a se donner.""*

7 ar)" "Morality as sign language."

7 [48]

We cannot conceive the beginning of moral judging (in other words, morals –) modestly enough, a beginning which came late, perhaps millennia later than morality: that is why I took pleasure in watching R(ée) attempt to construct the entire, wonderful gothic edifice of morals upon a few clever assertions, a few errors, a few forgettable assertions! I myself had other

foundations: but we both had in common the tendency to think that the foundations had to be as bad as possible.*

7 [49]

Everything works so shoddily and unscientifically these days – see the first page of Lecky!'

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7 [so]

Competent in war and competent in giving birth: this is immediately and supremely decisive.

7 [s]

Noblesse demands repaying like with like, even in revenge: the concern of those who still place limits even on their own affects – it is just the same with gratitude. But what business does the state have with this noblesse!

7 [52]

The most free action is one where our truest strongest most subtly integrated nature springs forth and in such a way that

our intellect simultaneously shows its controlling hand. – There-fore the most arbitrary and yet most reasonable action!

7 [53]

the argument against revenge grounded in unfree will would also be an argument against gratitude: the fact that the doer is

unfree has nothing to do with our repayment of good deeds.

7 [54]

Reward and punishment corrupt our ability to see the natural consequences of every action.

7 [55]

How can the state take responsibility for revenge! First, it is coldhearted and does not act through affects: which someone taking revenge does. Next, it is not a person, much less a noble person: therefore it also cannot demonstrate its noblesse and self-discipline in the process of keeping things in proportion (as in "like for like"). Third, it robs revenge of precisely that which leads to the restoration of injured honor: the voluntary forsaking of life, danger for the sake of honor. It would therefore offer satisfaction only to the ignobly thinking injured party, while, on the contrary, robbing those who are noble of the opportunity to restore their honor. – Finally: it presupposes the shamelessness of the injured parties: who must speak publicly of their injuries! The "complaint" is, after all, a demand made by the state! But the noble person suffers in silence. – Thus only base natures are able to see the state as a tool of retribution. Hence the bitter struggle against the state on behalf of the vendetta. – Pasquale Paoli was forced for this reason to portray the surrender to the whole as something nobler – as a sacrifice! – and to demand the renunciation of vendettas as a superior kind of self-overcoming: for this reason he denounced anyone who takes revenge. The state affords protection to those who are weaker, who are incapable of defending themselves against evildoers: punishments are therefore initially security measures, also insofar as they deter. The state does not want us to defend ourselves – it does not fear revenge, but rather sovereign mentality! Therefore: subjugation to state justice is a self-sacrifice, of no benefit to more noble people. Given this, the state itself

must have functioned as something that was felt to be superior:

in short, faith in the sanctity (venerability) of the state must be

older than subjection under the exercise of state justice: older

and stronger! The nobility maintains for a long time its high

status in regard to children and slaves: thus its sovereignty. –

The impulses of heroism, not the standpoint of prudence, were

crucial to the emergence of the state: the faith that there is some-

thing superior to the sovereignty of the individual. Here respect

for the extended family and for the elders of a particular extended family plays a part: the younger generation makes offerings to it. The veneration of the dead and the transmitted

wisdom of ancestors: people of today make offerings to it. –

Here homage to someone who is intellectually superior and victorious plays a part: the delight at encountering our own idol in the flesh: here oaths of fealty emerge. – It is not coercion,

and not prudence, that hold the early forms of the state

together: but rather the outpouring of more noble impulses.

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Force would be impossible to impose, and prudence is perhaps still insufficiently developed in the individual. – A common danger probably provides the impetus for coming together:

and

the feeling of new collective power is something compelling and

is a source of more noble decisions.

7 [56è

At one point there was a theory of the state as a calculable utility: now we have the practice of it! – The time of kings has

passed® because the people are no longer worthy of them:

they do not want to see in their king the archetype of their ideals, but a means to their utility. – This is the whole truth!

7 [57]

Human beings would certainly like to have something like

supreme purpose, ultimate goal, absolute duty, (absolute) ought: the demand for these is the cause of the many moralities. But what is the cause of these demands? Probably many factors, e.g., – once it has taken control of the intellect, every single human drive probably demands to be recognized as the ultimate lord and goal-setter of all human matters. The most disparate drives have erected their monuments in moralities. 7 [58]!

There are moralities which are meant to /egitimate their creators in the eyes of other people: other moralities are meant to pacify and satisfy the creators; with other moralities they want to nail themselves on the cross; with others they want to take revenge on other people; with others they want to conceal themselves; with others they want to glorify themselves, whether in their own eyes or in the eyes of other people; with others they want to elevate and improve themselves, with others they want to exercise power and creativity on humankind; with others they want to obey, with others to rule and humiliate. With others they want to forget or be forgotten. Enough, moralities are nothing but a sign language of the affects.

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7 [59]
not the intention of an action, but rather precisely what is unintended about it, determines its value or disvalue.

7 [60]
Moralities as sign language of the affects: the affects themselves, however, a sign language of the functions of everything organic.

7 [61]
Quite apart from the value of such assertions: such as “there is a categorical imperative!” it can still be asked: what does such an assertion say about the person who is asserting it.

7 [62]

It is just now dawning on people that music is a sign language of the affects: and eventually we will learn clearly to recognize musicians' systems of drives by analyzing their music. They certainly wouldn't think that they were revealing themselves in this way. This is the innocence of these self-confessions, as opposed to that of all written works. But there is also this innocence in the great philosophers: they are not aware that they are speaking of themselves – they think it has to do "with the truth" – but really it has to do with them. Or rather: the most powerful drive within them forces itself to the surface, with the greatest shamelessness and innocence of a fundamental drive – it wants to be master and, wherever possible, the purpose of all things, of everything that happens! The philosopher is only a kind of occasion, and enabling means, whereby the drive speaks for the first time. There are many more languages than we think: and people reveal themselves much more often than they would like. What doesn't speak! – yet there are still so few of those who hear people babbling forth their confessions, as it were, into empty rooms: people are squanderers with their "truths," as 7 SPRING-SUMMER 1883 235 the sun is with its light. – Isn't it a shame that empty rooms have no ears? There are viewpoints that make people feel: "this alone is true and right and truly human; anyone who thinks differently is wrong" – these are called religious and ethical viewpoints. It is clear that a sovereign drive is speaking here which is stronger than the person. Here, each time the drive believes itself to be in possession of the truth and of the highest concept

"human."

There are probably many p(eople) in whom one drive has not become sovereign: they have no convictions. This is there-fore the first characteristic: Every philosopher's closed system proves that in this philosopher one drive is the ruler, that a fixed order of rank exists. This then calls itself: "truth." – The feeling here is: with this truth, I have reached what it means to be "human": the other is of a kind inferior to me, at least as the kind of person who knows. With primitive and naive people, convictions even rule in regard to their customs, indeed in regard to their tastes: it is the best possible thing. With cultured peoples, tolerance rules in regard to such matters: but in that case there is an even more strict adherence to their highest standard of good and evil: whereby we want to have not only the most subtle taste but also the sole legitimate taste. This is the universally dominant form of barbarism, not yet knowing that morality is a matter of taste. Incidentally, in this area we find the most /ying and de-ceiving: moralistic and religious literature is the most mendacious. The ruling drive, whatever it may be, employs deceit and lies against the other drives in order to maintain its superiority. Alongside religious wars there persists a moral war: i.e., one drive wants to subjugate humankind; and the more that religions die off, the more bloody and visible this struggle will become. We have just begun!

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7 [63]

Apperception is first and foremost only activity "voluntary" movements!)

7 [64]

My theory: in every action of a person, the entire development of psychic life is experienced™
even sense perceptions are actions: in order that something can be perceived, an active force must already be functioning, a force that registers the stimulus, allows it to work and adapts to a stimulus like that and modifies it.
It is a fact that something absolutely new is continually being generated. "Cause and effect" is merely the popular generalization of "means and end" i.e., of another popular logical function to which nothing in reality corresponds. There are no final appearances, except to a being that has already created a beginning and an end.

There is also always something new being generated in the development of the mind. Feelings® and representations are absolutely not derivable from each other. Thought and feeling!®

7 [65]

The "voluntary" movement of the lowest organisms is — — —

7 [66]

First: how can people be made capable of ruling themselves?
second: how — — —

7 [67]

Digesting everything that the past has produced is certainly not what is most desirable: that's why I wish that Dante would offend our tastes and appetites in some fundamental way.

7 [68]

To regard Hamlet as the pinnacle of the human intellect — that's what I call not judging intellect and pinnacles harshly

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enough. This is above all a failed work: its creator would probably laughingly admit this if] said it to his face.

7 [69]

Why has a judicial reward not developed alongside judicial punishment? Why has the state not also taken responsibility for the individuals' gratitude toward others?

"Justice," according to Ihering, securing the conditions of life

within society by means of compulsion.°®

An act is not evil in itself, but only insofar as etc."

e.g., a troublemaker can be killed without penance

martyring and torturing on behalf of the state

stealing among Egyptians

Collective conscience and collective responsibility.

It is not the guilt that is punished.

Crime as misfortune.

To distinguish between bad (contemptible) and evil.

Morality among the powerful and the subjugated.

Tremendous complexity of the emergence of current moral

value determination: but unity as feeling.

Anyone who refuses to punish on account of freedom of the will is also not entitled to praise, to thank, to be angry: the

fundamental belief of all affects while interacting is – – –
7 [70]

Desire for revenge® is awareness of being injured, first as a mat-

ter of fact, second with respect to our belief in our power (rationality,

formidableness etc.) Both require a counterresponse, thus:

1) defense,

2) substitution, and 3) generating a feeling of power: leaving aside

completely the belief in the perpetrator's guilt. The desire for

revenge has nothing to do with belief in the freedom of the will.

7 [71] Organic – moral. Freedom of the will.

Evil as the preliminary stage of a good.

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7 [72]

"What is good for me is good in itself" is only the judgment of someone powerful who is accustomed to assigning value.

7 [73]

Perhaps it has never been seen as a problem that moralizing happens at all. Is it necessary that human beings will always

moralize?® Or couldn't morality die out, just as astrological

and alchemical speculation has died out or is dying out?

Nec-

essary for what? For life? But it is possible to live

without judg-
ing morally, as plants and animals show. Or necessary for a
happy life? The abovementioned animals show that in any
case it is possible to live more happily than human beings –
even without morality. Therefore morality cannot be neces-
sary
either to life as such or to becoming happier: without going
so
far as to make morality responsible for the fact that human
beings suffer more than animals: – suffering more in this
way
could certainly have other causes and morality could perhaps
be a means of warding off a great deal more suffering. But
it is
certainly the case that if becoming happier and becoming
more free of suffering were the goal we had to set for
ourselves:
a gradual bestialization would be rational: which would in
any
case also have to include refraining from moral judgments.
So,
if humans want not just to live and not just to live more
happily:
what do they want? Now, morality says: we should act this or
that way – why “should”? Therefore morality must know this:
this why, this goal, which is neither life as such nor be-
coming a
happier person. – But it doesn’t know this! it contradicts
itself!
It gives orders, but it is incapable of justifying itself. –
Giving
orders is the essence of what it does!
So what purpose does morality serve? Away with every “thou
shalt”!

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7 [74]

The feeling of “being bad” is completely different at that
level where guilt is not actually connected to intention:

Oedi-

pus (more disgrace and unhappiness)

Actually, there is no “badness” in noble morality: yet
“evil” still

has something about it that inspires reverence or compas-
sion.

7 [75]

Actions e.g., stealing are accompanied by completely differ-

ent categories of feeling and judgment once they are seen as allowed.

It is possible to show, through the comparison of peoples, that this is perceived as good in one place and bad in another: but

the opposition itself of "good" and "bad" is present everywhere:

it is just that actions are classified otherwise. – And yet there are

also differences in the universal judgment good and bad!

7 [76]

Animals follow their drives and affects: we are animals. Do we do anything else? Perhaps it is merely an illusion when we

follow morality? In truth, do we follow our drives, and is morality merely a sign language of our drives? What is "duty"

"justice" the "good," the "law" – which drive-life corresponds

to these abstract signs? –

When morality says: "you should become better" – why

"better"? – Neither life nor the prospect of a happier life can

demonstrate this. Hence the indemonstrable imperative the com-

mandment without purpose – this is supposed to be morality?

Yet "better" – is in no way conceivable without purpose.

7 [77]

What is the source of actions? That is my question. For what purpose? to what end? is something secondary. Either from pleasure (overflowing feeling of force, which must exhaust itself)

or from displeasure (restraining the feeling of power, which

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must free itself or ensure compensate for itself) The question:

how should we act? is posed: as if something could not be accomplished until an action has taken place: but what is most

proximate is the action itself as success, as what is accomplished,

apart from the consequences of the action.

Therefore, people do not act for the sake of happiness or utility

or in order to avoid displeasure: but rather a certain amount

of force is released, seizes something on which it can vent itself.

That which is called "goal," "purpose," is in truth the means for

this involuntary explosive process

And one and the same amount of feeling-of-force can be discharged in a thousand ways: this is "freedom of the will" – the

feeling that a hundred different actions serve just as well in

relation to the necessary explosion. The feeling of a certain

choice of actions in regard to this release of tension.

My solution: the degree of feeling of force makes the mind fertile; it displays many goals, chooses one goal for itself which,

when pursued, is tension-relieving for the feeling: thus, there is

a double discharge: once in anticipating a tension-relieving goal, then in the action itself.

"if I did that, I would despise myself, and then I would be unhappy." This would therefore mean: not to do a deed because

of the consequences for my feelings."

Helvétius thinks that when the possibility of an action arises

in us, we basically ask "what will be the consequences of this

action for my feelings?"7!

Stendhal sur l'amour v. p. 252.7?

Yet the first fact is that this possibility appears to noble people:

they see something about which simple souls have no idea.

An overflowing charged feeling of force is there: the goal set for the action provides an anticipation of tension relief and

thereby pushes even more toward discharge; the resulting action

provides the actual tension relief.

So it is! The goal that is set brings the desire for discharge to its

peak.

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Therefore: happiness, "le plaisir"? as a goal of action, is only a means of increasing the tension: it must not be con-

fused with the happiness that lies in the action itself. The final

happiness is very determined; the happiness in the action could be expressed through a hundred such precisely determined images of happiness.

Therefore: the "in order that" is an illusion: "I am doing this

in order to harvest the happiness from it." This is not the way it

is. The person who acts forgets the actual driving force and sees

only the "motive."

"The happiness in reaching a goal" is itself an offspring of the

tension of forces. an analogical anticipation and self-escalation.

Eudaimonism is therefore a result of imprecise observation. We

do not act for the sake of enjoyment: yet that is the illusion of the

person who acts.

7 [78]

Dühring Coursus p. 147, "the mechanical state of the body is a partial condition of cosmological mechanics""4

7 [79]

"I must not punish him – for he can't help it" – this "I must not" means: I would act irrationally, as if I wanted to punish a tree that had fallen and killed someone.

7 [80]

Fearful people, with vivid imaginations, who would be ready to subjugate themselves and to reconcile very easily – become increasingly obsessed with thoughts of endangerment that spring out of fear and imagined fear and for this reason

easily take disproportionate, deadly revenge – revenge for suffering

that they had mostly only dreaded.

7 81]?

Organic beings have 1) the force to bond chemically 2) particular explosions that regulate these chemical processes.

When

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both of these conditions coincidentally happen in conjunction

with each other and simultaneously, so that the temporal join-

ing and (the) force of these explosions work to regulate the bonding and dissolution processes, then there emerges an organic being. This is therefore the result of these two older kinds of beings.

such regular exploding and such growth processes.

7 [82]

Accusers do not want to admit to themselves how useful the pain was to them. Their drive for revenge is revealed in this

way: with words they wish to hurt and to exert their power over whatever wounded them.

7 [83]

How much more we live with a sense of well-being is revealed by the fact that pain is felt so much more strongly than a single pleasure.

7 [84]''°

Truth and courage only in those who are free (truth a kind of courage)

The evildoer as an unhappy person: form of humanity.

Servitude makes someone bad.

we don't react to most injuries, rather we submit. (Missing in

Dühring!)

7 [85] noble – good

Characteristics of persons – later applied to actions.

7 (86)''

1) Struggle of the parts for space

for nourishment whether with or without stimuli''

2) direct struggle with destruction or assimilation of the weaker''?

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3) the stronger produce more offspring than the weaker?'

the advantage always belongs to those who have a greater tendency to more easily regenerate themselves and to consume less.

greater capacity for self-nourishment and less consumption for

their own needs – applying this morally! – favorable preconditions for growth and, with it, autocratic rule.®!

When nourishment is lacking, the first to die out and starve will be those who consume the most nourishment.®?

Advantage to those who, under stimulation, use up their own resources the least rapidly, even more so where assimila-

tion of nourishment and regeneration thereby become stron-

ger, indeed are made stronger by the stimulus to the point of overcompensation.®?

Morally: the value of pain, of injury

Ability to resist pressure gives advantage

7 [87]

In themselves, courage, shame, anger have nothing to do with concepts

physiological facts, the name of which and the psychological conception of which, are mere symbols

What does language express about the names of the affects?

ira®4

What does it mean: to change a person through morality?

therefore physiologically through chronic fear or extreme agitation exhaustion

To study the effect of illnesses on the affects.

7 [88]

my task: to position the good drives so that they get hungry and have to activate themselves.

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7 [89]

Concerning the existence of highly perfected mechanisms of adaptation Roux p. 43 Emergence of animals out of the water

7 [90]

The characteristics that are typical in a family first become

fully visible in the man; the least visible in easily stimulated,

excitable adolescents. Tranquility must have set in first and

the number of external stimuli reduced: or on the other hand the excitability must have significantly subsided. – That is why peoples past their prime are so eloquent concerning their

typical characteristics and make them more clearly known than

they did in the bloom of their youth.

7 [or]

Struggle leads to the survival of the best.

7 [92]

Rivalry among citizens, it's always the most industrious who achieve an enduring influence: thus the state continues to exist.°8

Relative autonomy of the parts even in the highest organisms Roux p 65.

7 [93]

Concerning the inequality 3? that really exists Roux. 69.

7 [94]

In the same way that, physiologically, cell borders cell, so,

too, drive borders drive. The most comprehensive image of our

being is a socialization of drives, with continuing rivalries and

individual alliances among them. The intellect object of the competition.

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7 [95]

When a quality of the cell is chemically constituted such that assimilation outweighs decomposition, therefore overcompensation for what is consumed, growth appears: this important feature thus establishes dominance over the other q(ualities).

We don't know of any organism, any cell, that would not have this force in one stage of its life: life would not be able to

propagate without this force.

The struggle for nourishment and space takes place in the cell as soon as there is an inequality of constituent parts."°

Processes which increase their capacity for life, namely for assimilation, through additional stimuli: where therefore the

stimulus has a trophic, nourishment-increasing effect – funda-

mental condition for plants, the nourishment of which is entirely dependent on sunlight and warmth (even electric light produces

rapid unfolding and fructification.?!)

Thus, influence of stimuli on more rapid assimilation – in morality: increase in power at the place where a plethora of the

most subtle injuries occurs and, with that, an increase in the

need for appropriation. (Even more so with exotic foreign ideas

– Greeks.)

The more easily reactive substance accommodates more

stimulus??

7 [96]

Justice – the will to perpetuate a particular power relationship. Satisfaction with this is the prerequisite. Everything worthy of honor is added in order to allow justice to appear as something eternal.

7 [97]

Practical consequence. Transformation of character. Breeding instead of moralizing.

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to work with direct influence on the organism instead of the indirect influence of ethical breeding. Then another kind

of corporality is already creating for itself another soul and

ethos. So reverse it!

in Socrates, a plebeian mistrust of the affects: they are ugly,

wild – therefore to be repressed – that's why Epicurus is ahead

of the Stoics in terms of nobility. Yet they are more understandable

on a popular level.

In much the same way, the Christian saint is a plebeian ideal.

7 [98]

Processes emerge where a stimulus becomes necessary, becomes a stimulus to life: otherwise deterioration and decline set in.

These are the supreme processes ??

All of this occurs without the struggle among individuals."

Selection in the struggle among individuals will choose those

characteristics for lasting preservation that prove to be useful

for the whole individual"

Therefore: many kinds of morality must emerge – the struggle among their supporters and their triumph result in lasting

preservation for the kind of morality that is useful and indispensable

for the few of the most powerful.

Innumerable attempts at moral value judgments must have already been made, depending on the development of separate

strong basic feelings:

Absolute requirement that the best morality must be associated with the most powerful individuals. who are they?

All states and communities are inferior compared to the individual, but are necessary forms?® of the individual's higher education.

7 199]

The "real meaning" behind" accusations is that people always intensify their pain: so that they do not let it go too

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quickly – thus drawing upon even superior forces, the sculptors of themselves!

7 [100]

To have a subtle knowledge of what hurts us and of how easily others hurt us, and as it were to influence their thoughts

in advance so that they do not act in ways that are painful to

us: this is the main thing for many amiable people: they bring

joy and allow the joy in others to pour forth – because they are so frightened of pain. This is called "sensitivity" – Those

with a reclusive hardened nature have no need to put themselves in other people's shoes and often hurt them; they do not

assume such a great susceptibility to pain.

7 io]

the self enhancing aristocratic principle is always inventing

superior types among superior people. Powerful people gain ever more power over themselves, exude ever greater force: we see

that nobility has many levels – and something in the individual

person is growing on its own.

7 [102]

Power as imagined by those who have had to fear it.

7 [o]

The pleasure we take in people who are similar to us, as our duplicates, is only possible if we take pleasure in ourselves. Yet

the more this is the case, the more our taste is offended by what is

foreign: hatred and disgust for what is foreign are as great as our pleasure in ourselves.

This hatred and disgust result in our destroying and remaining cold to everything that is foreign.

But if we take no pleasure in ourselves, this can be used as a

bridge to universal human compassion and becoming closer

1) we demand the presence of others so that we forget about ourselves: conviviality in many people 2) we assume that others

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also take no pleasure in themselves: and once we perceive this,

they no longer provoke envy "we are equal" 3) as we come to tolerate each other, despite feeling displeased with ourselves, we

get used to tolerating even "those similar to ourselves." We no

longer feel contempt; hatred and disgust dissipate: becoming closer. In this way the doctrine of universal sin and depravity

brought people together. Even the truly powerful are imagined

differently: "basically they are poor miserable people."

7104] people who are walking legislation

7 [os]

the judgment "good" appears within us as taste: as tyrannical and certain as a taste for sour pickles or as when I can't

stand to be in the presence of someone spitting.

7 [106]

do not lose the affect of distance!

7 [107]

Conquering – is the natural consequence of excess power:

it is the same as creating and procreating, in other words the

incorporation of one's own image into foreign material. That is

why superior humans must create i.e., impose their superiority

on others, whether as teachers or even as artists. For artists

want to communicate themselves or, more specifically, their taste: artists for their own sake is a contradiction. It is the same

with philosophers: they want to make their taste dominate the world – that is why they teach and write. Wherever excess power exists, it wants to conquer: this drive is often called Jove, the love for those with whom the conquering instinct would like to have its way. – Vain people want to please, they want to exist according to the taste of others: in this they show their lack of creative force – they are “empty.” Dissemblers hypocrites, even clever, cautious people fear the taste of others: a lack

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of surplus force is the prerequisite here. Whereas imprudent reckless defiant unconcerned straightforward hasty incautious

qualities are more easily found in the presence of a quantity of

force, which increases the tension too much and quickly explodes

into action – in opposition to utility. This also explains why

attention to prudence is not respected by the powerful: being

prudent can easily be an indication of lack of force. On the other hand, in some circumstances imprudent actions are noble:

and this is perhaps why unselfishness is praised: unselfish people

i.e., those who do not act out of prudence and caution but like

those who spill over – what do they care about the direction?

Calculating people are despised: but those who calculate for the

entire community are all the more admired. For we assume that people are not superfluously “prudent”?! thinking is regarded

as difficult, – – –

Thus emerges the praise of wisdom: as the praise of someone who thinks, calculates, deliberates often well and easily,

and not out of prudence for the sake of utility, but rather out

of love for the community, out of love for perpetuating its thoughts and institutions. This is something rare!

7 [108]

Fear of power as productive violence. Here is the realm of religion. On the other hand, becoming one with the most power-ful thing that exists appears to be the supreme human striving.

This is the origin e.g., of Brahmanism: generated within the imagination of the ruling caste as a fantasized expansion of the need for power, probably because this need has no release

in wars.

The union with the godhead can be desire for supreme sensual satisfaction (feminine hysteria in many saints) or desire

for supreme tranquility and stillness and spirituality (Spinoza)

or desire for power etc. Or even as the consequence of the most desperate fearfulness: the only salvation and escape is to

flee into God. The most refined form of this union may well be "overcoming grace" in the mystics.

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7 [109]

Conscious intention in a harmful action is not considered "evil" in itself, but rather insofar as it allows foreigners, enemies

to appear more dangerous. "They have evil intentions toward me," or "they have evil intentions."

As long as enemies are felt to be present, features of the ignominious contemptible are still lacking in evil actions. Only

when evildoers show themselves to be simultaneously harmful and pitiable, does an action become morally suspect. Thus, morality begins with contempt.

7 ko]

Those who lie often and knowingly and live under conditions where it is dangerous and difficult to lie, are, for that

very reason, sensitive to the truth, even to an extraordinary

degree: whereas idealists and do-gooders constantly live in a

fog concerning themselves and their desires and basically can

never speak the truth: – their “taste” is not subtle enough
for
this.

7 m

Those who, as poets, want to pay with pure gold must pay
with their experiences: for this reason, though, poets re-
fuse to

tolerate having their closest friends as interpreters –
their

closest friends figure things out by giving them feedback.
Yet

these closest friends should be amazed at where those poets
emerge on the paths of their suffering – they should learn
to

look ahead and above and not backwards, below. –

7 [112]

Granted, that punishments should inflict pain in proportion
to the severity of the crime, then they would also have to
be

determined in proportion to every criminal’s sensitivity to
pain, i.e., there should never be a predetermined punishment
for

any offense!

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7 (133)

“Good people” emerge only when there is a feeling of opposi-
tion: these are people who are simultaneously harmful to
them

and yet contemptible. Lawgivers make an effort to endow
many actions with this character, so that they appear con-
tempt-

ible, associated with disgrace: so that an action and its
accom-

panying disgrace occupy a single feeling. – In general, it
is our

custom”? to regard all criminals in the same way. It is oth-
erwise

where lawbreakers are admired or win excessive favor through
great heroism and disdain for danger. E.g., heretics and all
sec-

tarians often win admiration as opposed to the contempt that
initially greets them. It is evident: there is power in-
volved.

7 [114]

Public-spiritedness'® is older than selfishness, in any case
it

has been stronger for a longer time. The differences in mentality were in fact not great: and so the value of actions was not judged at all according to mentalities, but rather according to consequences. The species believed in itself and its mentality as a fact of nature: people readily expected to find their own mentality in all their neighbors –actions were simply not weighed any further, “they were all self-evident.”

7 (115)

People say one thing and do something completely different: even moralists do this. So what’s the point of moralizing? Be honest for once! The main point is, that we have to do it. Every “what’s the point” is nothing but shadow-boxing and embellishment.

7 [116] “representative virtue”

7 (117)

Nature wants nothing but always achieves something: we want something and always achieve something else. Our “intentions” are only “coincidences.” –

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7 [18]

When human beings do everything for the sake of their happiness and yet devote very little thought to what makes them happy: the result is that, for them, reflection brings great displeasure.

7 [119]

Great men!”! like Caesar Napoleon are a living species! Every other form of ruling is imitation.

7 [120]

39) Our actions reshape us: in every action certain forces are exercised, others are not exercised, thereby eventually falling into neglect: an affect always affirms itself at the expense of other affects, from which it drains some force. The actions

that

we perform most often eventually become like a thick shell around us: they readily make use of the force, it would be difficult

for other intentions to prevail. – Not doing something on

a regular basis reshapes a person in the same way: eventually we

can tell whether others have overcome themselves a few times every day or have always let themselves go. – This is the initial

consequence of every action, it continues to sculpt us – our bodies as well, of course.

40) Now opinions about these actions, generated by us concerning ourselves, are also a part of each action. Our opinion

about ourselves is just as much a consequence of each action – it

adds to the total assessment we have made of ourselves, whether weak, strong etc. praiseworthy blameworthy, whether we should avoid the judgments of others, whether we can show ourselves in any light. Perhaps self-deception becomes a

habit: the consequence of this, intentionally flawed appraisal

and squinting of the eye, seeing falsely, must of course ultimately

reveal itself again in our actions. Deceit used against

us, lack of trust in us, fear of us, contempt for us – all of the

affects belonging to impotent natures progressively alter the body

as well. The awareness of a lack of self-control, un-noble!"?

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expressions creep in – and even if someone were living on a desert island.

7 21]

38) Completely leaving aside all other people, the value of a

human being undergoes constant change, becoming better or worse:

1) because every action builds on a person's system of affects

2) because the appraisal associated with each action builds

on it and becomes in turn the cause of subsequent actions.
That which is base, un-noble grows – or dissipates etc.
Baseness corresponds to a completely corporeal substrate,
and certainly not just in facial features!

7 [122]

NB. Absurdity of all praise and blame

7 [23]

the pride of the weak is so fragile because they fear that
no
one believes in their energy and force.

7 [124]

It seems like only yesterday Kant proposed in all seriousness

that we should only perform actions etc.!

7 [125]

As for me, I have grown accustomed to observing a primitive kind of sign language in all moral judgments, through which certain physiological facts about the body would like to

make their presence known: to those who have ears to hear it.°3 But who has had ears to hear it until now!!%4

Now in fact that there were no ears to hear it, or wrong ears,

and false interpretations (existed), and that for millennia, consciousness continued such vain attempts and interpreted itself –

this proves it.

this proves it.

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And so I believe that the understanding of morality does have a future and that hopes for improving the human body might come with this better understanding.

7 [126]

37) Anyone who has developed some idea of the body – how many systems are working simultaneously there, how many things are done for each other and against each other, how much subtle accommodation, etc. is there: will conclude that all consciousness is meager and limited by comparison: that no mind is even remotely capable of reaching what was supposed to have been accomplished here by the mind and perhaps, too, that the wisest ethicist and lawgiver would have to

feel clumsy and amateurish in the middle of this mechanism of warring duties and rights. How little we are aware of!

How

much this limited awareness leads to error and confusion!

Consciousness is but a tool: and considering the amount and significance of what is accomplished without consciousness, neither the most essential nor the most worthy of admiration.

On the contrary: there is perhaps no organ so poorly developed, no other that is deficient in so many ways, no other that

malfunctions so much: it is after all the organ that emerged last and is therefore still a child – let us forgive it its childish

tantrums! These include, among much else, morality as the compendium of all previous value judgments concerning human actions and mentalities.

Therefore we must reverse the order of rank: everything conscious is only of secondary importance: that it is nearer and

dearer to us would not be a reason, at least not a moral reason,

for appraising it differently. That we take what is nearer to us to

be more important is nothing but age-old prejudice. – So learn

to see things differently! in major evaluations! That which is

mental is to be preserved as sign language of the body!

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7 27]

Morality an attempt by the affects to become conscious of each other.

7 [128]

34) The recognition of authority increases in proportion to the

decrease in creative powers

7 [129]

35) False oppositions. All stages still exist alongside one another

(or many) – but the higher stage does not want to recognize the lower stage as way and means – it should be its opposite!

This is the affect of distance. Anyone who does not possess or

show it provokes the greatest confusion e.g., Epicurus.

7 [130]

36) The same thing e.g., self-control in some people leads some-

one else to think “you have to watch yourself around them,

they only consider, coldly, what is to their advantage and
ulterior advantage"! – and someone else might think "you can
let yourself go in their presence and show yourself as you
are
– they will not go to extremes" plurality of all character-
istics,
depending on the degree of prudence, or considerations of
beauty-nobility.

7 [131]

The Future of the Science of Morality

In bidding farewell to moral problems for a while, in order
to avoid the danger that I myself will no longer find the
time

to come back to this subject, I want to provide a few hints
to

those etc.

7 [132]

so whether the superior species might not be better and
more quickly achieved by means other than the terrible game
of wars between peoples and revolutions? –

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whether not through nutrition selective breeding elimination
of certain experimental groups

7 [33]

Our body is something far superior more refined more
complicated more perfect more moral than all of the human
organizations and communities known to us: the small size of
tools and servants at its disposal is not a fair argument
against

it! In matters of beauty its achievement stands supreme: and
our works of art are shadows on the wall compared to this
not

merely illusionary but also /iving beauty!

7 [134]

The expansion within a state of pleasure (in Mainländer,!"
p. 64).

It wants to "show its state and expose itself to others – if
it

were possible, to the entire world" hugging, hopping, dan-
cing,

jumping, laughing, screaming, cheering, singing, speaking –
I see an overflowing force that wants to expend itself

In displeasure, approximately this way: "the gleam in the
eyes is extinguished, the countenance becomes white, the
limbs motionless or contracted. The skin of the forehead

wrin-

kles, the eyes close, the mouth grows silent, the hands make fists, the persons cower, collapse into themselves."!°"

The temperature changes: the extremities become cold: hotter in pleasure and in anger.

7 [135]

Key questions: can temperaments be changed?

33) The qualities of the will are "comparable to scorings into

which the will flows at the slightest stimulus: they have expanded

themselves into channels" "But infants already show great depths

under mere scorings: character (its form of temperaments)"!%

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Qualities of the Will.

7 [136]

envy greed cruelty miserliness infidelity pride defiance imperiousness immodesty baseness rigidity cowardice injustice obduracy trickery brashness sensuousness vileness vanity "moods"

states of the will "movements that are felt"

257

magnanimity generosity mercy prodigality fidelity humility pusillanimity mildness modesty noble-mindedness flexibility temerity

justice

openness honesty bashfulness moderation desire for honor saintliness.!0?

sense of life (equanimity) – its modifications:

joy courage hope love hate despair fear sorrow.

Double movements

110

Wrath, rage (first the will flows back, concentrates itself (hate), and then suddenly flows to the periphery, in order to destroy)

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7 137)"

30) The starting point of praise and blame: weak people praise

and blame because this and that are praised and blamed: strong

individuals present themselves as the standard. The same applies

to the moralists and their own feeling of power – depending

on whether they feel themselves to be lawgivers or teachers of laws that have been given.

In the utilitarianism debate!!? both sides are in agreement –?

Bentham feels himself to be a lawgiver, Rée a ruled subject.

7 [138]

“The condition of our muscles determines in large measure our kinesthetic feeling of health and strength, fatigue, illness

and weakness – with every movement of our body we know enough to estimate with incredible exactness (as with the act of seeing) the degree of contraction that we have to force our

muscles to achieve. We also know the different positions that

our muscles assume, even when they are at rest: we acutely feel

a fatigued limb and especially a lame limb.”!!°

7 [139]

Cold objects appear to weigh more than warm ones of the same weight (according to Weber)!”⁴

When 2 sensations follow each other at close enough intervals at the same place, they tend to melt into each other: the

same thing happens when sensations occur in very close proximity on the skin.!”⁵ 7 [140]!”⁶

Love: the most powerful outpouring, the will would like to break out of its sphere, to become the entire world.

Love as based in the quality of will imperiousness

as based in the heart

as based in quality desire for fame (as pleasurable feeling of intellectual superiority)

as based in fidelity (as friendship)

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7 a]

Erroneous simplifications: e.g., seeing something as a means while overlooking 100 things.

7 [142]

NB. a moral feeling something very complex. It has to do with

the fact that saying “good” has such a different effect than saying

“useful,” because 50 additional ingredients are mixed in.

7 [143]

The unconditioned is only logically derived from the conditioned, like nothingness is from being. – As “unconditioning” –

7 [144]

27) All of the wonder we have invested in nature up to now we

must also learn to feel when observing the body: it is pathetic

to let ourselves be tyrannized by “big” and “little” like this!

What the forest, the hills, would have to say to us – and the

distant heavenly bodies “which call us to solitude”!!” (Emerson) – “these delights are good for us, they make us

sober.”!!8

7 [145]!

28) The meaning of our gardens and palaces (and similarly, too, the meaning of all desire for wealth) is, to remove disorder

and coarseness from our sight and to build a homeland for the

aristocracy of the soul.

Of course most people believe that their natures become superior once such beautiful serene objects have had an effect

on them: that explains the mania for Italy and travel, etc. all

reading and going to the theater. They want to be shaped – this is the meaning of their labors on behalf of culture!

But the strong powerful want to do the shaping and want to have nothing foreign in their presence anymore!

29) This is why people go into the great outdoors, not to find

themselves, but rather to lose themselves in it and forget them-

selves. “To be outside oneself” as the wish of all those who are

weak and dissatisfied with themselves.

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7 [146]

Advantage enjoyed by cold natures: they pursue their interests as a colder thing.

7 [147]

To accept nothing when we have nothing to give back and

the shame and pleasure we experience in the presence of every-
thing good – is noble. “Allowing oneself to be loved” is common.

7 1148]

The mother’s compassion for her child is almost like the compassion we feel for ourselves: artists feel the same thing for their work and their fates. There’s nothing noble about it: there is also compassion for ourselves – it is something completely different from suffering itself!

7 [149]

With “ends and means” we are speaking a sign language: but in this way we indicate only what is peripheral about actions

(their relationship to the accompanying phenomena pleasure and pain)

7 [iso]

24) Contempt for the body is a consequence of dissatisfaction with

it; and the overvaluation of the mind and of moral laws is the

state of those who habitually want to become something superior

and who believe they can become greater by strolling around among “eternal values.” All this demand for the everlasting!° is

the consequence of dissatisfaction – such is the will to culture,

as a demand of “people dissatisfied with themselves.”

7 first]

25) The body’s beauty – this has been understood too superficially by artists: this superficial beauty would have to be followed by a beauty in the whole inner workings of the organism

ism

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– in this way the greatest sculptors provide inspiration for creating beautiful human beings: this is the point of art – it provokes

dissatisfaction in those who feel shamed by it and inspires creativity in those who have sufficient force. The result of a dra-

activity in those who have sufficient force. The result of a dra-

activity in those who have sufficient force. The result of a dra-

matic performance is. "that's just how I want to be, like this hero"

– stimulation of the creative force, turned back on ourselves!

Epicurus is to the Stoa as the beautiful is to the sublime: but

we would have to be Stoics at the very least in order to be capable

of seeing this beauty in the first place! in order to be able to be

envious of it!

7 i)!"

26) Our age with its striving to remedy accidental difficulties, to

prevent them and to combat unpleasant possibilities in advance,

is an age of the poor. Our "rich" – they are the poorest of all!

The real purpose of all wealth is to forget!

7 [153]

Teichmiiller p. 204 the I compares its imaginary representative content and finds the awareness of something that happened before (or of a content given in memory)

Thus, in all perceptions of time the I is active. "To atempo-

rally bring together and compare the acts {of} memory sensation

and anticipation – this is the activity of the I."!??

7 [154]

Against Kant. Of course I feel connected, even to the beautiful that appeals to me, through an interest in it. But this

interest does not appear in its naked state. The expression of

happiness perfection stillness, even that aspect of the artwork

that is silent, that lets itself be judged – everything speaks to

our drives. – In the final analysis I perceive as "beautiful"

only that which corresponds to an ideal ("the happy person") of

my own drives e.g., wealth, celebrity, piety, an outpouring of

power, for different peoples, capitulation can become the feel-

ing "beautiful."

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7 i]

20) Great enough to gild what has been despised: intelligent enough to understand the body as something superior – this is the future of morality!

In our intentions and will we must fervently seek the sublim-

ity that we so worship in nature – we should be the redeemers

of nature and not its deifiers! "Deification of nature" – this is

the result of poverty, shame, anguish, stupidity!

Our actions should be misunderstood, as Epicurus is misunderstood! It is characteristic of all prophets that they were under-

stood soon – it diminishes them! We must first have human beings whose significance becomes evident after centuries – our "fame" has thus far been something wretched! – I do not want to be understood for a long time.

On the other hand, we must endure misunderstanding things and seeing more than what is there: oh you who do nothing more than understand "great humans"! Your force should be such that you see superior beings that are a hundred miles above them! And this is what I call idealization: to see a sun-

rise where – a candle is lit!

Death would shine most brilliantly if it /ed us further into the

other world, if we took pleasure in everything that is becoming

and for that reason even in our passing away!

7 [156]

21) Noble feeling is what forbids us from being merely people

who enjoy existence: it rebels against hedonism – we want to accomplish something in opposition to it! But the masses believe

in their hearts that life must be lived for nothing – this is their

vulgarity.

7 [157]

Judging humans from the standpoint of animals! Are we not their parasites?

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7 [158]

22) The parasitical as essential element of the vulgar mentality.
the feeling of receiving nothing without giving something in return or of thereby receiving something in return is the noble mentality. Nothing for nothing! No "favors"! But also no sufferings, no — — —
7 [159]

23) "For the wise person, nature transforms itself into a tremendous promise" Emerson.!?? Now, you yourself are nature and you promise, along with it, something tremendous and you are probably careful not to reveal your own secret too quickly!
7 [160]

18) The gods as the cause of evil (sin and suffering) I 232!?*
So how did badness come into being where there are "good people"?
Because of fading insight — and this is often the work of the gods.!""
7 [161]

19) Aidos'?" is the impulse and inhibition against injuring gods, human beings and eternal laws: therefore the instinct of reverence as habitual among good people. A kind of disgust at injuring what is worthy of being revered.!?"
The Greek aversion to excess, in the joyful i(nstinct of) hubris, (against) any transgression of their boundaries, is quite noble — and highborn! The injury of aidos is something terrible to behold for someone accustomed to aidos.'*8
#600 = ÜPo!" satiety, to be intoxicated with happiness
Hubris and rage are mutually exclusive (Eudem. Ethicsb), for hubris presupposes a joyful condition, rage a painful one.!*°
Those who were free, moderate invented competition as an ever more sophisticated refinement of the need for the exercise of power: through competition hubris was averted: which emerges when the lust for power is not satisfi(ed) for a long time.
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Envy – pain over present or past happiness of friends: an entirely Greek concept!!*!

If rage is “sweeter than honey”!?? – sweeter than rage – – –
7 [162]

The devil becomes envious of anyone who suffers terribly and banishes this person into heaven.

7 [163]

14) When slaves do philosophy

What are slavish natures? The ones that do not know what is good and just, Socrates says. According to Theognis, betray-

ing a friend is a sign of slavish mentality.

Their dependence makes it impossible for them to be truthful 1, 266133

7 [164]

Quite remarkable. Plato, Timaeus p. 86 etc. (I 281) mental ill-

nesses brought on by faulty disposition of the body: the task of

the educators and the states is to provide healing in such cases. If

healing cannot be achieved in time, then the educators and the

states, and not the sick, are to be held responsible 4 – – –
7 [165]

“Pathological tendency to loot temples”! Greek.

7 [166]

How little imagination we have for the suffering we inflict on others!

7 (167°

16) Present-day slavery: a barbarism! Where are those for whom

they work? – We cannot expect that both complementary castes will always exist at the same time.

Utility and fun are slave-theories of life: the “blessing of work”

is a self-glorification. – Incapacity for otium.’*’

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7 [168]

[15) Way of thinking common to old people. according to Aristotle-

tle, mistrust, lack of strength of feeling,!?® fearfulness, inquir-

ing about the utility of everything and not the moral worth.

The true joy of old age consists in being revered says Pericles.

(Simonides thought it was pleasure in profit.)!??

7 [169] The Origin" of Morality.

The moralists themselves are among the facts of morality.

When noble people employ morality When slaves and women re-
tribution When the aged When sick and degenerate people When
inactive people

Development and downfall of a morality, conditions

Mor(al) instinct.

organic function of good and evil

Conscience

7 [70]

Struggle between different moralities a means of cultivating
them. Stagnant moralities (Chinese)

7 71]

12) Compassion: traced back by me to involuntary imitation
of signs that are observed.

7 [172]

13) The actions that constitute the well-being of the commu-
nity, of the organism, did not emerge for the sake of this
purpose:

all moral customs have a prehistory – every kind of action
originally had another purpose and meaning. – Just as seeing
was not the goal in the emergence of the eye, and just as
eyes

have in turn been used for the expression of feelings: "*"

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7173]

Means of self-expression, of self-disclosure – originally
how-

ever the intention of self-disclosure was absent, rather all
com-

munication is actually a wanting to acquire something, a
grasp-

ing and wanting to appropriate (mechanical). To incorporate
the

other – later to incorporate the will of the other, to ap-
propriate

it, this has to do with conquering the other. Self-disclos-
ure is thus

originally extending our power over the other: an ancient
sign

language underlies this drive – the sign is the (often pain-
ful)

imposition of one will upon another will

to make ourselves understood by blows (ants)

NB. Even the injuries done to others are a sign language of

the stronger

Thus, understanding is originally a sensation of pain and the recognition of a foreign power. Yet quick, easy understanding

becomes very advisable (in order to receive as few blows as possible)

the quickest mutual understanding is the least painful way of relating to each other: that is why it is so sought after (

negative sympathy – originally the creator's? *of the herd*.!?

7 [174]

8) A moral way of looking at actions – the organic functions of

individuals for whom the individual is not the purpose but rather a superior principle (the superior principle can be a community): or even more so: attempt at conversion into organic

functions. Wherever living things come together, there continually arises a mutual influence and a gathering together in

the attempt to see whether an organism can be formed. Similarly human to human).

Yet even bad actions should be examined as having functional characteristics! their usefulness in this non-individual sense!

The organism exists by means of struggle

10) NB. The accompanying phenomena have been transformed in many respects: some things are now associated with displeasure, formerly with pleasure. Even great moments of cleverness

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may in earlier times have given the impression of inspiration:

an entirely different appraisal of cleverness, as demonic.

11) The pleasure in doing damage, malice, defamation, estrangement

because of passion. Murderous intent. Under what circumstances natural? When pathological? Atavism?

7 [175]

9) So are laws made against wicked people? Against innovators

and not against wicked and bad people!

The "bad person" is first generated as a contrast to the good

person.

So even moral conscience is something relatively late, bad conscience at the same time as good conscience (continuous delight in its impulses!) therefore active!

7 [176]

Striving for happiness is foolishly interpreted by people as striving for enjoyment; and the crippling capacity to enjoy things is

considered to be an argument against egoism. Hartmann p 591.4

7 [177]

Complexity of today's mor(al) feeling. In today's feeling: "ethi-

cal" is present: the drive of reverence, helpfulness, nobility,

devotion, courage, piety, the drive for advantage purposeful-

ness, for the common good

7 b]

4) On moral instinct. Most prevalent in very ancient unchanged

peoples.

We do not inherit our ancestors' knowledge as animals do: as a result of great changes in lifestyle Roux 37 4° – but some-

thing of the kind is present in all nonmigratory peoples, pre-

cisely the moral instincts are the result of many similar experi-

ences among less migratory peoples. If a great migration ensues,

then the instincts are soon lost. There are a number of time-

tested behavioral rules (initially attitudes and gestures, like those

of defense, reverence etc.) that are instinctively chosen.

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7 [179]

Epicurean theory. Pain ensues when a desire, a wish is inhibited-

ited in its satisfaction. Pleasure, the clearing away of the obstacle-

cle – negative. To seek pleasure – would be nonsense, would be to seek something negative! Not to suffer would be the goal

instead! Where there is pleasure, an earlier displeasure can

be

presupposed.'46

7 [180]

6) Where the means of power are not great enough, intimidation appears, terrorism: thus any punishment for the sake of deterrence is a sign that the positively outflowing virtue of the

powerful is not great enough: a sign of skepticism regarding its

own power.

7) A power must stand solidly on its own two feet and have its

center of gravity. Counterpart to that: Schmidt, II 269.1 To this there corresponds a kind of morality. –

7 [181]

5) Inactivity: Just to take a breath is the highest thing there is!

Otium in the best case – not creating!

7 [182]

NB. Egoism is not a moral principle, is not “Thou shalt”! for

it is the only “You must.”®

7 [183]

The problem of the competition!” among different moralities: the Hellenic concept in competition with the Athenian. The community and the superpower. II p. 273.'°°

1) Competition among moralities

The masculinity of the nation is disappearing p. 274:'7! how that is manifested in the culture. Epicurus.

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7 [184]

Beauty imparts the intuiting soul with the impetus that makes it capable of conceiving noble thoughts. Plato.!?

7 [185]

II 353 it is disgraceful, according to Socrates, when a good deed cannot be repaid. Thus there is no “innocent acceptance”

in Greek friendship. To base our friendships on bestowing good deeds! Pericles – Athens. important!

2) Power-morality.

7 [186]

There is a continuous chain of injuries in response to injuries,

even on a small scale: in war, we can no longer know who the evildoer is. Blood feud is merely the strongest expression of all

such interactions among equals.'*

3 Retaliation

7 [187]

It is not unjust to rejoice at the suffering of enemies –
Soc-

rates II p 357.5

7 [188]

Diogenes: attaining virtue requires either staunch friends
or

fierce enemies.°°

7 [189] Hatred moral, envy not!"

Happiness in the harm done to enemies p 362.'

7 [190]

Struggle among tissues must lead to a balance among the
parts, or else the whole perishes.

Tissues which are too vital, no matter how beneficial, bring
destruction upon the whole. Tumors, e.g., are a kind of tis-
sue

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endowed with abnormal vitality: they expand to other tissues
at the cost of nourishment and space and destroy the whole.

One tissue can achieve dominance, merely through the abnor-
mal

weakening of another tissue!"

The lack of balance between tissues quickly leads to the
death of individual tissues and to the elimination of them
and

of their disadvantageous qualities from the ranks of the
living:

only the conditions of balance remain: in this way a harmon-
ic

unity of the entire organism would be engendered by the
self-elimination of the deviant tissue.

Struggle among tissues becomes a regulating principle: prin-
ciple of functional self-design of the most suitable propor-
tions.'

7 [rox]!

Among the most powerful factors governing the develop-
ment of a state are not only the struggle with neighboring
peoples and the development of defensive capabilities: but
also

the competition among members of a social class and the com-
petition among the social classes themselves.

7 [192]

Falling silent in the presence of the beautiful is a pro-
found

expectation, a wanting-to-hear the most delicate, distant sounds

– we act like someone who is all ears and eyes: beauty has something to say to us, that's why we fall silent and think none

of our usual thoughts. The silence, that introspection, patience

is thus a preparation, nothing more! This is the case with all

contemplation: –

But the serenity involved, the sense of well-being, the freedom

from tension? Evidently a very steady stream of force emanates

from us during the process: we adjust as it were to the high colonnades through which we stroll, and we impart the kinds of movements to our soul, that through peace and gracefulness, are imitations of what we see. Just as a noble gathering

inspires us to noble gestures.

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7 [193]

First, assimilation into the work, later assimilation into its

creator who spoke only in signs!

7 [194]

"Up to now all good characteristics of an organism have been derived solely from selection among individuals in the struggle for existence!"!%

7 [195]

Resisting the foreign, not allowing its allure to become formative –

but rather setting a thick skin, hostile feelings against

it: is for most people a necessity for survival. Yet the saintliest of

saints live among criminals as if in their element.

– the open-mindedness! of morality therefore finds its limits wherever someone perceives the allure of the foreign to

be only harmful, not stimulating.

Those who are rich in saintliness are at home among the most evil people: and all nay-saying is the province of impoverished people.

7 [196]

just as the active quantitative and qualitative variety of nutrients determines the entire development of cells so, too, does the human being choose from among the events and stimuli, thus working actively among all the random intrusions – thereby repelling many of them. Roux p. 149."

7 [197]

The parasite forces the host to encase it in a cocoon and a larger surrounding container p. 151.'°°

7 [198]

Drives are superior organs, according to my understanding: actions perceptions and states of feeling growing more entwined in each other, organizing themselves, nurturing themselves – – –

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7 [199]

Evil people as rudimentary Schneider p 29.1"

7 [200]

Vanity and the drive for distinction have opposite origins. Just as words were considered to be congruent with things, so too what we said about people was considered to be congruent with them: we did not doubt a person's ability to know absolutely (be known absolutely)' of a person. That's why an opinion about someone was absolutely decisive: and why vanity is now only an atavism: originally this drive was not yet so

debased (vain people today are skeptical about themselves) / n

earlier times, the thought did not even exist that people could

have a value for themselves, a concealed value. To be concerned about the good opinion of others – was identical with "being good." – Vain people subordinate themselves and want to please; those who strive for distinction want people to see

them ranking themselves higher, they want to be admired.

7 [201]!°? Morality for Moralists.

Up to now, moralists can be distinguished from each other according to their prevailing biases, in this way: some are fix-

ated on how people act toward each other; others on how people should act toward each other. But what both these kinds have in common is evident as soon as we allow them to explain the little word how? "What motives determine ac-

tions?

That is what we ask": this is what some people say. "What motives should determine human actions? This is what we ask" so say other people. That motives determine actions wher-

ever there is action, this is their common presupposition: this

is their common error; they have all done a poor job of exam-

ining the foreground of the entire moral landscape, indeed overlooked it – the fact that there is action, and that there has

to be action, and that so-called motives do not provide the explanation for this.

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7 [202]

Actual morality is infinitely more subtle, more complicated, more thoughtful than theoretical morality; the latter still stands awkward and embarrassed at the starting point.

7 [203]

All conservative powers have in themselves a kind of Jesuitism:

they believe the truth is there, seeking it is forbidden.

"Justice"

e.g., should be there!!!""

7 [204]

Utility an exalted principle! Indeed, not to be underestimated! But it concerns itself with means ("subordinate purposes") – the valuation and the code of values must already be there!"

7 [205]

Due to hunger, preferring poisoned bread to not eating at all!

7 [206]

Will as striving for pleasure: presupposes that willing itself

desires its own end. Hartmann.!'?

7 [207]

That which an action achieves is what catches the eye: the motive should lie in the representation of the result of the action

(e.g., an emotional state that is achieved)

7 [208]

"What people want, without reflection, and nothing further, is pleasure: "happiness a multifaceted, depleting and

last-

ing pleasure." (Hartmann).''?

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7 [209]

With Epicurus everything depends on finding the proper balance of pleasure and displeasure: therefore pQdvnotc!"4

is

the chief virtue, the basis: morality of prudence.

The significance of sensual pleasure is to free us from desires

and needs which disturb the dtagaéia!"> of the soul.

Bliss as ultimate purpose of the individual life. Aristotle and

everyone else!!7°

So it is the predominance of the concept of purpose that has corrupted all moralists up to now. "Life must really have a 'for

what?""!

That even the rational conscious life is a part of the development of

life without purpose – ego.

7 [210]

The actual assessment of life depends on generally prevailing

moods: when they came to South Asia, the Aryans perceived all actions as suffering and all feelings likewise: profound serenity in the shadow of the highest balsam. It is a mistaken

decision about where to settle, refined to the highest degree and

made into a decision about the value of life. (Even the emergence of the state a matter of fatigue!)

7 lu]

Superior organs develop on the basis of drives and these organs struggle with one another for nutrition, stimuli

— — —

The hand of the pianist, the pathway to it, and an area of the brain, together make up an organ (which must close itself

off to be able to contract strongly enough). Separate parts of the

body telegraphically connected – i.e., drive.

Schopenhauer added the unconscious purpose to this!

7 [212]

What is essential about all actions is purposeless or indif-

ferent

with respect to a multitude of purposes.

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7 [213]

Renunciation of earthly bliss in favor of the thousand times greater heavenly bliss is good business. Christianity and its cleverness!

good in Hartmann p 26.77

Reward and punishment with Christ.

It is folly not to accept Christianity.

7 [214]

We should do good in secret so that it is not rewarded here Luke 14 (12-14) – otherwise the heavenly reward might slip away from us.!'®

7 [215]

The more hopeless and wild the conditions on earth, the more fervent the belief in heavenly reward: since a person can-

not count on earthly happiness. The more superstitious the people, the more fervent the belief in hell.!"?

7 [216]

Punishment meaningless in the case of unfree will? But then we could not promise anything, could not take on obligations etc., could do nothing. Since we can confidently expect a lot of

ourselves,!®° i.e., advantages are given to us. We are disadvantaged when we cannot do what we have promised: or else we are

belatedly compensated for the advantages that were given to us earlier. (Punishment here as the delayed compensation of advantages that were granted to us, a revocation of social security etc.,

displaced into a state of enmity. Society is deceived in its assessment of punishment: it takes as much as it can from the power of the evildoer as remuneration, e.g., forced labor etc.)

7 [217]

Today I said "oh, this is a good person!" At the same time I had a feeling as if I were holding in my hand a beautiful ripe

plump apple with soft skin: a feeling of tenderness, as if I

were

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drawn to this person: a feeling of security, as if I were allowed

to rest here under a tree: a feeling of reverence, as if an object

were present that could only be grasped with the cleanest hands: a feeling of satiation, as if I were liberated from dissatisfaction at a single stroke. Thus, a state corresponding to the

moral judgment "good" arose in me when I thought of a certain person. It is the same as when I call a rock "hard."

7 [218]

When bliss is impossible (Hegesias), then the absence of suffering becomes the goal of life: without purpose, the goal of life

was not understandable!®!

7 [219]

Common striving of all ancient philosophers for freedom of thought and for casting off all the chains of slavery. It is the

atavistic nobility of idle people who have nothing more to do

and let themselves decay!®?

7 [220]

Taking the avoidance of the causes of pain to its logical conclusion – this is the practice. Here we preserve the completely empty life and the thinking about this emptiness. Here

the question arises: so there is no redemption from life?!®?

7 [221]

This belief in purpose leads to pessimism.

Conversely: the purpose is not to feel happy; people are led back from the false paths of life; the more we suffer, the true

purpose is achieved "There is an unmistakable touch of intention-

ality in all of this." Schopenhauer! *4 Hartmann p. 42 "Morality

a palliative against choosing a radical cure" p. 43 "the evil deeds

done to us actually a blessing."

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7 [222]

In cynicism the worthlessness of life is recognized, but has not yet been turned against life.

No: many minor triumphs and a big mouth are satisfying here!!⁸⁶

7 [223]

Teichmüller: feelings of pleasure or displeasure are signs of

the position that the I takes as a whole, over and against indi-

vidual activity: all of this is will, insofar as we consider the I as

the single point of reference: the two opposing basic forms: desire and loathing. If we consider another point of reference,

then the activity itself, as such, remains unconscious, yet its

accompanying what becomes conscious every time, and so

this what becomes a sign of that which we want to designate.

We call the accompanying ideational point of reference an evil

or a good, corresponding to loathing or desire, and designate it

by means of the content of accompanying sensations or intuitions. All images of our intuition and all our activities stand in

particular regular relations to one another e.g., the intuition-image of the rose and the sensation of its fragrance.

In

this way, even a child designates one thing a means, another thing an accomplishment.'®'

7 [22.4]'88

First absurdity: all life is willing of a purpose

egoism is the will to our own happiness

Second absurdity: it is moral to serve a foreign will and self-denial.

thus the purpose of life does not lie in happiness: first insight!

the purpose of the ethical life should lie in the will of another.

But what then is this will of another other than a will to satisfaction?

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My opinion: intentions wishes purposes are secondary –

“striving for happiness,” in general, doesn’t actually exist at all,

but even striving for the happiness of others and not striv-

ing

for our own happiness ("renunciation") is not at all possible in the first place, whereas a partial striving for personal happiness is possible.

All actions yield a lot, even for others!

The individual will pursues the purpose: happiness – impossible to find it!

Thus, the individual will must adopt another will as its purpose,

it is the means to another person's purpose –

But, Mr. von Hartmann! As soon as it promotes a will at all, whether our neighbor's or of the world-process – then it

is certainly working to prolong misery: and indeed after it has

already comprehended that all will is essentially miserable!

Hence its promotion is either madness or evil.

Yet there is a second absurdity presupposed here, that an unego-

istic action is possible.

The first absurdity: all action is a willing of satisfaction

the second absurdity: there is an unegoistic action an action

as not-willing of our own self, but willing of a foreign self!

7 [225]

The setting of goals is itself a pleasure – a quantum of intellectual-

force is expended in means-end thinking!

7 [226]

Willing, a pressing feeling, quite pleasant! It is the accompanying phenomenon for all outpouring of force.

much the same for a// wishing in itself (entirely apart from fulfillment)

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7 [227]

Let us not fail to recognize the profound lack of noblesse of

feeling in Christ, his Jewishness, the tidy profits and the irritation

at the stupidity of missing out on them! The Europeans have read so many nobler feelings into this! '®°

7 228]

We select the facts,^o we interpret them – unconsciously.
The wishes that stick with us –
Running counter to our purposes and all conscious willing,
there exists a greater kind of reason, in all our actions,
much
more harmony and subtlety than we consciously imagine ourselves to possess.

7 [229]

We still have not freed ourselves from the logical mania of antiquity, they prized nothing more than the dialectic – like-

wise “intentions” “purposes.”

7 [230]

Most people are completely incapable of experiencing anything: they haven't lived in solitude enough – an event is immediately washed away by something new. Deep pain is rare and a mark of distinction. In everyday life there is more

prudence than in Stoicism. – Avoiding pain.

7 (231]

all our purposes, seen from a certain distance, become exceptional

as tests and throws of the dice – there is experimenting going on.

We must preserve whatever is arbitrary illogical about our best purposes!

We would never act if we imagined all the consequences.

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7 [232]

Weakness-of-will as consequence of disorganization and as sign of decline.

7 233]

Kant says: I endorse these sentences of Count Verri (1781 sull'indole del piacere e del dolore)'''* with complete confidence

il solo principio motore dell'uomo è il dolore. Il dolore precede

ogni piacere

il piacere non é un essere positivo.'''*

7 [234]

“To feel our life, to take pleasure in it – to feel ourselves

continually driven to abandon our present circumstances, pain

which for that reason must be as frequent as it is chronic.”!°4

7 235]

"The rational will may only lessen pain and repress needs."

—!°

7 [236]

Cardanus concluded, we must seek out as much suffering as possible in order to create a greater sum of pleasure through its elimination. !%°

7 [237]

"Shortly before the pupal stage, all actions of the larvae are

directed at the preservation of the final insect, rather than at

its own preservation, they do not correspond to the needs of the larval stage, but rather to those of the completely developed

creature" etc. Schneider I p. 58!77

7 [238]'8

The highest principle"? of Jesuitism also that of socialism:

Ruling humankind for the purpose of satisfying it

Satisfying humankind by maintaining illusion, faith

In response my countermovement: —

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Ruling humankind for the purpose of overcoming it.

Overcoming through teachings that bring about the downfall of humankind, except for those who survive them?"

Fundamental error up to now: "all human actions are consciously purposeful."

"the purpose of the human being is the preservation of the species and only incidentally the preservation of the person" —

current theory.

This is the case, too, with people who are very individualistic—

we take care of our future needs!

7 [239]

Original form of all protective movements, upon unpleasant contact drawing itself together, drawing all parts into itself. What

is the psychological equivalent? In summary: pain makes us concentrate.

The drive to conceal something is shame, a protective drive: also wanting to conceal ourselves, when hummingbirds e.g., become red in the process (is an effect of fear!)

Human beings are guided by their instincts: purposes are chosen only to serve the instincts. Yet instincts are an-

cient habit-

ual actions, ways of expending their available force.

The result achieved by an instinct should not be called "purpose"!

To give our drives completely free rein: yet often they come in conflict with one another. Actual life is a wrestling match of

instincts, a growth of some, a waning of others.

"Use of stored up nervous energy."

"Which idea leads to action? That which awakens the strongest drive. Which is that? That which promises the greatest comforts, the most pleasant idea. This is not a rule which allows

exceptions, but is rather a Jaw, and the dependence of the human

will rests on it" Schneider p. 75

! But the drive itself first called forth this idea! – I say.

Thus: drives decide the expenditure of accumulated force, not that action is undertaken in the first place. The how? is

the province of the drives.

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Thus: when we become aware of a drive, it promises pleasure. Promised pleasure as the cause of action? – Not of action in the first place, but only of the specific direction of the agent!

So, too, Stendhal.

Thus: wherever ideas lead to action, there the person must follow the idea that promises the most pleasure: the strongest

drive decides the choice.

Accordingly, morality must be changed 1) first, the accumulation of force must be considered 2) second, the expenditure of

force, the how?

The first principle, overlooked up to now.?"!

7 [240]

First fact: society kills, tortures, robs??? freedom, robs property-

commits violence through restrictions on education; through schools; lies, deceives, harasses (as police) – there-

fore all of this cannot be regarded as bad in itself. – Society

desires its preservation and advancement – this is not a

sacred
 purpose: it fights for this against other societies. – Thus
 all of
 this happens for the sake of utility. But mad! Precisely
 these
 actions should be accorded special veneration and respect:
 as
 “justice,” ethics, preservation and cultivation of the good.
 That here the needs of the many are prioritized over those
 of
 the few, this would only make sense if we assume that the
 individual cannot have more value than all of society! Yet
 the
 intention here, from the start, is to prevent such individu-
 als
 from emerging at all: the image of human beings that is used
 as the measuring stick for the preservation of the common
 good is already available. The assumption of society must be
 that it represents the supreme type “human,” and from this
 it
 derives its right to fight against all that is hostile to it
 as what
 is hostile in itse/f – Without this faith in itself, society
 is
 “immoral” in every sense. Yet until it has faith, it does
 not
 determine what should be moral. – it makes sense this way!
 7 SPRING–SUMMER 1883 283
 7 [241] (End Justifies the Means.)
 There are actions that we will never allow ourselves to en-
 gage
 in, not even as means to the noblest?TM end e.g., betraying a
 friend.
 Better to perish and trust that there will be more favorable
 circumstances for achieving our noblest end. – But what sort
 of noblest end is involved in preserving a community, a
 state!
 The action of one person who sacrifices the state in order
 not to
 betray his ideals can be the noblest accomplishment of all,
 whereby
 the entire existence of this state becomes a matter for pos-
 terity!
 7 [242]
 Presupposition made by the state up to now: “the human being
 should not develop further, the mold is there!” The Catholic

Church (the oldest of all forms of the state in Europe) now best represents the ancient state!

7 [243]

Trade requires a patriciate: therefore a counterweight.

7 [244]

The point of punishment is the elimination of parasitic humans.

Birds that keep parasites away from a buffalo, live off it – thankful that they signal to him the arrival of an enemy. –

Meaning of the police. Espinas p. 159.74

7 [245]

Incessantly busy listening and paying attention to one another

and thereby the feeling of security – p 162.7

7 [246]

Affection the consequence of a fervent need?

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7 [247]

Tracing punishments in their kind and essence back to war or to sacrificial cults (human sacrifice)

In one case, the fundamental thought behind punishment is return to precommunal conditions, in another case, mockery

of the gods. Post I, 201207

A punishment meted out to unfree people becomes demeaning for that reason e.g., lashes as punishment). The punishment

meted out to free people has long been regarded as ennobling

for that reason. Post I 214.7%

7 [248]

“– the only direct value judgment we presuppose is that of sensualistic well-being, and we believe everything else to be

indirectly realizable through a connection to this direct will-

ing. Observance of laws, morality, religion is supposed to be

induced by reference to well-being in this world or the next”

Baumann p. 32.70?

Universal belief in the value of sensualistic well-being: every

action should be a path or a detour to this.

7 [249]

Legal prohibitions only make sense when there is no need to

achieve something in this way that is prohibited: in other words, if there is another way – i.e., very specific promises

and concessions are a part of all prohibitions.

7 [250] The center of gravity

210 shifts in word, in use, in respect –

7 [251]

“the good of all with exclusion of the individual” Hartmann p 6057"! pathetic hypocrisy!

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7 [252]

That the difference between a scoundrel and an honorable man does not consist only in a few differently convoluted brain movements –

7 [253]

Strength of character. To take in very many stimuli and to let them have a deep effect, to allow oneself to be distracted

almost to the point of being lost, to suffer very much and – nevertheless to persevere in our general direction.

Typical strong character types are cold, shallow and devoid of sympathy: they also do not take possession of other people.

Plastic force.

7 [254]

Our choice is greatest wherever our practice and our spontaneous energy is greatest: it is the readiest docility and agility in

the one who obeys (free will perceived most strongly, wherever

we are the least creatively restricted) Baumann p. 18.1

7 [255]

A book of sayings and quotations

a book of anecdotes. A book of facts. Jokes.

7 [256]

Egoism is not a principle, but rather the one fact.

7 [257]

From the standpoint of purpose, as much is squandered in every action as from the heat of the sun radiating into the universe.

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7 [258]

The individual as fruit of the communal entity, not always as means.

7 59]

Every condition may be considered as if it had been purpose,

or as means or as a misstep in an experiment.

7 [260]

Satisfaction of a drive is not to be sought in the result of an

activity, but rather in the performance of it.

Happiness would be the equilibrium of the triggering activities of all drives.

7 [261]

Experimentation as true character of our lives and of every morality: something voluntary ??? must be involved!

7 [262]

Origin of Christianity among collectives of the poor. Baumann

p. 227!4 divine aid and mutual support.

7 [263]?

The idea of an action's joyful beneficial result brings joy, exhilaration, blood flows more freely. In this way the purpose

of an activity has an additional exhilarating, pleasurable force

during the action.

Thus: the activity of the drive is tied to pleasure. The goal of

the activity is imagined and causes pleasure in the same way that increasing the activity does (the goal is the activity of

another drive). But the drive itself does not will a result of

what it does. Our drive to understand certainly takes pleasure

in determining the purpose – this is its activity; just as it does

in devising the means – logical pleasure in all actions.

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In every action many drives are active.

At the very least

1) the one that finds satisfaction in doing

2) the one that finds satisfaction in setting end and means

3) the one that finds satisfaction in anticipating success.

The drive finds satisfaction i.e., it is active when it takes con-

trol of stimuli and transforms them. In order to take control of

them, it must struggle: i.e., it must hold back another drive,

subdue it. In truth, it always exists as an active drive:

but nour-
 ishing it engenders /arger amounts of force, so that even
 its
 output of force must be different. Yet the drive itself is
 nothing
 other than a particular way of being active: a personifica-
 tion.

7 [264]
 Effect of reward and punishment p. 31 Baumann.?!¢

7 [265]
 A stimulus is in itself neither pleasure nor displeasure,
 but it
 can certainly be accompanied by pleasure or displeasure
 there
 cannot be a middle ground that would be neither pleasure nor
 displeasure! – what is “not pleasure” is just not pleasure!

7 [266] Will as the form-giver?

7 [267]
 Satisfaction: the word presupposes discord and awakens
 prejudice.

7 [268]2!”

1. Innocence of becoming: without purpose.
2. Action, drive, pleasure, free will.

in the meantime the economy of our drives far outstrips
 our insight.
 the essentially erroneous self-observation within all agents
 has turned into morality.

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“Individual as result.” Collective conscience.

6. Punishment, revenge, the responsibility. (End justifies
 means)

Morality as sign language of the body.

8. Taking possession of history under the guidance of
 stimuli and drives – there is no “objective history.”
9. Evil a precursor of the good: that which is creative and
 those who create: the new value judgment and its history.
 The organic function of evil. (Humankind as mass of force
 which increases and must expend itself)
10. “Living for others” and the “unegoistic”

Hartmann, p. 593

7 [269]
 Much less intention in our deeds than we pretend (vanity in
 assuming purpose!). Emerson, p. 99.7!

7 [270]
 The future of humanity not that delicate a concept. Against
 this p. 599.71?

7 [271]

With an "in order to" an action is deprived of its value.

7 [272]

"Good" "bad" corresponds to the states of those who judge.'""°

7 [273] The individual as multiplicity.

7 [274]

Point of departure: the denial of moral significance – Birth of Tragedy.

[8 = Mp XVII ra. Summer 1883]

8 [i]

The Tonga-islanders cut off their little fingers as a sacrifice.!

In the Orient a woman covers her face when surprised while bathing – in this way decency is maintained!

Shame prohibits women in China from showing their feet, among the Hottentots they merely need to cover the backs of their necks."

White is the color of mourning in China.'

The ancient civilized peoples of the Americas were not familiar with milk.'

The Chinese eat very many dishes in very small portions.

No. 29.

People do not want to take on the flaws of animals e.g., the cowardice of the stag (in Borneo) – women and children are permitted to eat them.'

Even bats frogs worms larvae caterpillars are eaten. Rats that have been fattened up a delicacy of the Chinese. "Eating tiger hearts makes you headstrong" (Java) Dog livers make you clever.

The Siamese, e.g., eat incredible amounts of rice.°

8 [2]

– just as the bald eagle sits proudly and serenely above the falls of the Niagara and frequently dives into its churning mist'

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– just as the albatross abandons itself to the ocean for weeks at a time: the king of the birds

– just as the condor of the Andes at soundless heights (it can glide through the air for over an hour without beating its wings)?

Serenity of the one who flies?

8 [3]

What a difference we observe in walking swimming and

flying! And still it is one and the same motion: it is merely that the carrying capacity of the earth differs from that of water which in turn differs from that of air! Thus we should also learn to fly as thinkers – and not suppose that when we do this we are becoming fantasizers!!°

8 [4]"

The authority of Sir Andrew Aguecheek in Shakespeare: "I am a great eater of beef, and I believe that does harm to my wit"?

8 (s)!3-14

Punishments among the Germanic tribes: to have a millstone dropped on someone's head (mythical), quartering by horses, trampling by horses; to be boiled in oil or wine (14th and 15th

century); similarly in the Middle Ages being buried alive, walled in, starved. The rack (purely Germanic), flaying alive

(cutting strips out of skin). To abandon someone smeared with

honey to the flies and the hot sun. To hack off the right leg and

the left arm. Nose, ears, lips, tongue, teeth, eyes, private parts.!!>

8 [6]!6

Matrilineage: children do not belong in the father's family, but

in that of their mother's brother. The father belongs to another

family: father and son in a hostile relationship. The father marries

into a foreign family and in it he is solely a breeder, and little

more than a slave. – Patrimony is nothing self-evident but rather

a late-attained legal institution. The moral bond between father

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and child is lacking! The father is not considered related to his

children by blood. The umbilical cord is the family bond.

In associations of blood relatives there is neither individual

crime, nor individual property, nor marriage. Only the extended

family has rights and privileges. Women are communal property like children. Yes there are situations where there are no

personal relationships, instead only groups are related. – Group marriages.

Legal subjects are now so-called “natural persons,” the individuals:

they are the bearers of rights and obligations.

An old Chinese man said, he heard that when kingdoms are about to perish they have many laws.

Marriage with a bad conscience: before they marry, women must undergo a time of concubinage, they must be deflowered. They must give themselves to members of the tribe before belonging to one man.

Last vestige the *jus primae noctis*” of chieftains or

even priests (as with the Buddhists in Cambodia)

Concubines enjoy high standing in some parts of Africa, in India and in Java, they have remained true to the gods of the people. –

In this place, a husband supports, along with his wife, all of her sisters, in that place all brothers have a single wife.

Among animals the young females[®] are unadorned, beauty is the province of males – those who desire and fight become beautiful.

in our culture,!? women make “conquests”

The superior beauty of women among humans proves that here women are the ones who fight and feel desire; they easily

understand how to conquer men. Among animals masculine intelligence is enhanced by the sex drive. –

In Athens the men were more beautiful than the women – according to Cicero: yet this is probably a consequence of the

great dedication to beauty, under the influence of pederasty.

With the emergence of individual marriage a new obligation emerges, by which brothers and sisters, father-in-law and daughter-in-law, mother-in-law and son-in-law, brother-in-law

9

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and sister-in-law, may not speak, eat with one another, in-

deed,
may not even see one another. – In earlier times the mother and daughter were often married off together. – Hostility and coldness are among the obligations wherever individual obligations emerge. Animosity immediately appears whenever love does. Human love in general has yet to exist without intense hatred.

For a long time, marital fidelity had the appearance of being immoral.

Women as property, which the stronger man can take away from the weaker at any time. A test of strength decides the matter. Only the chieftains and priests have the beautiful women.

Young people must be satisfied with insignificant old women.

–

Abduction the customary means of acquiring a woman. the engagement ring as a remnant of the chains in which the abducted woman was dragged away
Originally absolute “coldness and indifference” between spouses. The woman has been bought or abducted. In addition, the secret reproach of conscience concerning marriage as

something unnatural and immoral: spouses live essentially apart, not sharing table and bed. Separation of the sexes the

basic idea behind Chinese marriage. The house (has) two parts:

the husband lives in the outer part, the wife in the inner part.

The door should be carefully secured. Each must die alone. It is

the *separatio quoad thorum et mensam*”? carried to completion.

Higher associations of lineal collectives: Many small communities with no contact at all with each other, of ten separated

by large forests, owing fealty and levies to a chief who does not

interfere in the internal administration of the small communities

(as today in India and Sumatra). This kind of community is as closed as possible from within: the Greek 26Ac,”!

Oldest division of classes according to age: piety.

The Tupinambazis fattened up their prisoners of war secured with long ropes and provided them with sex slaves, until they

were fat enough to be eaten.

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8 [7]?

Joking and high-handed treatment of other people used to have a dreadful meaning for us: namely of prisoners of war. Of

the insane: even old Don Quixote! Laughter is originally the expression of cruelty.

8 [8]?

One person originally: priest sorcerer doctor judge chief-tain. Rain peace good weather good harvests fat calves – but also birth defects plague misfortune in war or the hunt, bad weather.

Contempt for old age because of weakness in war and hunting. Killing of twins, at least of one of them. Twins are seen as proof of adultery (e.g., among the Caribs) Even the Germanic tribes had this way of thinking. – This multiplicity regarded

as bestial, similar to rats and bitch-dogs.

Here and there it is still considered shameful to bear daughters.

Ancient Germanic custom: the baby lies on the ground until the father declares whether he will allow it to live or not. If he

does not pick it up, it is left to die – just as among Fiji-Islanders

The chieftains are liable for the conduct of women and children, for damages done by slaves and animals. For blood debts" incurred by one of his own; he must pay their debts. Dowries. A completely different conscience emerges in such people.

Even now still the case in princes and statesmen.

For a long time, responsibility separated from conscience!

8 [9]

'Type of primitive family collective: a group of relatives descended

from the same ancestral mother, living with women, children and property completely in common, so that there is no marriage between individuals, no individual patrimony or parent-

hood; all members equally closely related, all property, movable

and immovable, as communal, all work communal; all produc-

tion consumed communally, all debts communal debts of the
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 collective, all blood relatives active in every blood feud
 and ob-
 ligated by the blood guilt of a blood relative. Foreigners
 taken in
 through adoption.
 Kin-groups and tribes take precedence over lineage. House-
 kinships fundamentally different from this as associations
 of
 descendants from the same ancestral father. Hardly a primit-
 ive
 construct: corporate group of men and women, children and
 slaves, united under the patriarchal authority of a chief-
 tain or
 house father. With its own gods, justice-system government,
 inalienable land. Not bound to the existence of individual
 members, preservation of the house-community first duty: and
 pressure to divorce an infertile woman: celibacy as punish-
 able:
 when the husband was impotent, the wife had the duty to con-
 ceive a child with one of his male relatives."
 Any place where the organization depends on blood ties,
 there are blood feuds: the collective life of the associ-
 ation
 comes to be expressed as force that is incomprehensible and
 transcends the individual, object of religious reverence.
 Basic
 tendency: the balance is restored between two families;
 indi-
 vidual guilt is irrelevant, it is war between families. As
 the
 state apparatus develops, the line blurs between blood feuds
 and acts of revenge against the perpetrator."
 Presupposition for blood feuds is initially that it is a
 family
 matter: to begin with, the territorial overlordship or the
 state
 does not get involved.® But it already presupposes the su-
 perior
 organization: it is a duel between equals, belonging to a
 single
 whole. Enmity toward the family of someone with blood guilt
 is fundamentally different from enmity toward anything nor
 belonging to the superior communal organization. Absent is
 the contempt, the belief in the inferior race of the enemy:

in
the blood feud there is honor and equal status.
Outlawing: a member is expelled from the social collective;
he is now completely without rights. Life and property can
be
taken (from him) by anyone. The evildoer can be killed by
anyone without retribution. Basic feeling: deepest contempt,
8 SUMMER 1883 295
unworthiness e.g., still in Islamic law in cases of heresy
or blas-
phemy against the Prophet: while in cases of murder and cor-
poreal injury it acknowledges only blood feud and compensa-
tion within the social collective. It is ostracism: hearth
and
home are destroyed, women and children and whoever lives in
the house are killed, e.g., in the Peruvian empire of the
Incas
whenever a sun virgin transgressed with a man her entire
fam-
ily and relatives had to pay for it with their lives, the
house of
her parents was razed to the ground etc. The same in China
when a son kills his father.??
Therefore: offenses that put the existence of the community
at risk provoke outlawing: the rotten offshoot is eradic-
ated.
What is regarded as such an irrevocable and fundamentally
contemptible act varies according to what is regarded as a con-
dition of the community's existence – and therefore can be
very different in different communities."
In practice all kinds of mitigation emerge, e.g., the of-
fender
is allowed time to withdraw by fleeing. Exile and confisca-
tion
of property are its furthest branches. In particular, pun-
ish-
ments involving denunciation have their origin here.*!
Social collectives: associations for protection and defense
in
which the members guarantee each other's lives and property,
in which disturbers (of the) peace are expelled from the
peace,
in which children, women, goods and guilt are held in com-
mon – most ancient form.
Formation of the state: a kingdom severed from the basis of

blood relations, a public state justice-system, individual property, individual arrest for crime and debts – most recent form. –

The more surely an organic entity, e.g., a community herd comes to self-awareness, the stronger its hatred of what is foreign.

Sympathy for those who belong and hatred of what is foreign grow in tandem.

In regard to the continuity of communal life and the quantity of thoughts which it calls forth: how limited is the extent of

the role played by purposes and images related to the essence of

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the individual self! Social drives far outweigh individual ones.

Animals perform self-destructive acts that benefit the group.??

To use the current language of morality (but corresponding to fundamentally different feelings), animal societies are based

upon love, constancy of affection, education of the young, work, frugality, courage, obedience by the weak, solicitude by

the strong, sacrifice by all? No society can survive without such qualities, and these drives are inherited by the society that

survives: at a certain level of strength they would make society

dull: but internal antagonistic forces arise in proportion to

increasing external security. And once a condition of external

peace is achieved, then society disintegrates into individuals.

Tension develops that had previously existed between communities.

Only then does compassion come into existence – as feelings

between individuals who perceive themselves as such.

(The

altruistic acts of those unified primitive societies presuppose an

I-feeling, but a collective-I, and differ fundamentally from communal-

passion.) Maybe one family first felt something like compassion

and respect for another family within a larger collective, thus

not for individuals. Here is the origin of compassion. My opinion:

blood feuds are the oldest form of this respect for another

family: as opposed to the absolute feeling of enmity.

8 [10]

Even "savages" are indescribably advanced humans, when measured in the longest span of time.

8 [x]*4

Human beings originally altruistic, more than any animal

– hence their slow development (children) and sophisticated training, hence also the extraordinary ultimate kind of egoism. – Predators have much more individuality.

8 [12]

Atavism: joyful feeling, for once being able to obey unconditionally.

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"Thou shalt allow thyself to be exploited, robbed, lied to"

–

the fundamental feeling of the Catholic priest-state, especially

perfected in Jesuitism. sacrificio dell'intelletto" ancient and

original – yet not perceived as sacrifice, but rather as the opposite,

as agony

8 [13]

Yes, the philosophy of right! This is a science which, like all

moral sciences, is not even in diapers yet! E.g., the oldest meaning

of punishment has yet to be recognized, not even by jurists

who imagine themselves to be freethinking – it is completely unknown: and as long as jurisprudence fails to establish itself

on new ground, namely in history and comparative studies of peoples, it will remain trapped in dreary battles between thoroughly

false abstractions that fancy themselves these days to be

"philosophy of right" and that are completely derived from

contemporary h(umans). Yet contemporary h(umans) are such a convoluted web, even in regard to their leg(al) valuations, that this philosophy allows for the most varied interpretations.
8 [14]

My first solution: Dionysian wisdom.

Dionysian: temporary identification with the principle of life (including the sensuality of martyrs).

Delight in the destruction of the noblest people and at the sight

of how they gradually come to grief

as delight in what is to come, the future, which triumphs over what is there, still so good"

8 [is]?

The Greeks as Connoisseurs of Human Nature.

The simplifying, the aversion to what is complicated, and to minor details

The logicizing, the presupposing of something logically comprehensible even with respect to character

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The idealizing ("beautiful and young"), the aversion to the atypical, the unconscious lying (taking sides against oneself, a

certain generosity, is lacking)

The political necessity of making ourselves commonly understood: the lack of hidden individuals II 398, of restrained

feelings (those called disreputable because of aversion to action

II 401).38

The competition. Feelings, with which every philosopher wanted to beat down his opponents – through the practical proof that he was the happiest. "Virtue is happiness" – from Socrates onwards, all psychological observation has refuted?

this; they defend themselves (the "feeling for facts" only developed

as reaction in agon with the mythical sensibility, not as

an original force).

(Perhaps they were simpler? – But the enormous abundance of different individuals.)

The nobility (yewatos meaning roughly "naive!"): instinctive action and judgment are good form; self-gnawing and self-decomposition is ignoble.

Their will to the "universally human," even initially to the

universally Greek – their sense of being the opposite of barbarians

Evil people encounter part reverence, part compassion; they themselves are not yet consumed by worms – the whole destructive churning self-contempt is lacking.

The “useless” waste of energy (in any kind of agon) as ideal to which the state aspires (as opposed to the Romans); they have little understanding for impetus arising out of pressing

circumstances, while the Indians (Brahmans), through lack of initiative, feel “all action is suffering.”

Stoicism would not have been possible at all in a morally enlightened world. – Every word of B. Gracián? or La Rochefoucauld or Pascal has the whole of Greek taste against it. they complain and leave it at that (the pessimism of Homer P « . » . « . O »

Sophocles Epicurus – “evasion” perceived as “divine”).

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thus: they suffer to the greatest degree, but they react to it

with such intense self-satisfaction in creating and also in speaking of things that are beneficial.

they are the people most susceptible to pain, but their formative power in using the pain is extraordinary: this also involves moderation in avenging pain, in wallowing in pain: a

need for a victorious attitude, as cure. Consequently they are

inclined to be dishonest about suffering: and in this way “their

sensibility” became less visible in proportion to the increasing

visibility of the conquering affects, brilliant intellectuality and

courage. Obsession with slander required the concealment of passions.

Thucydides as the greatest example of sidestepping the national aversion to anatomical treatment.

During the period of greatest productivity in forms, reflection is still missing from opposites (like Dionysian-Apollonian):

the facts are there.

The fine arts develop much later. To which can be added philosophy from Socrates onwards: – a drive to return from multiplicity back to a few types.

goal of the philosophers lively portrait of the most superi-

or

humans.

Among the philosophers absolute lack of a history of moral value judgments.

Antipathy to allowing another type to gain legitimacy.

(let's consider Plato: he denies greatness in everything else!

Homer, the fine arts, prose, Pericles – and in order to tolerate

Socrates, he reconstructs him!)

General impression: a certain superficiality in the psychological

(as opposed to Shakespeare and Dante and Goethe, as opposed to all of the French from Montaigne to Balzac, as opposed to Gracián (Christian skepticism) Italians J(acob) B(urckhardt) even

the Indic peoples are more profound in their analysis of the suffering human being).

But perhaps they were indeed simpler human beings? This

idea fits with "the youth of humankind" etc.

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Precisely here is the danger of a major error and mistaken conclusion. Suppose that the fine arts of the Greeks had per-

ished and we had been limited to the judgments of the philosophers: what a mistaken conclusion!

And likewise: all of their aesthetic judgments are far below

the level of their creations.

So a discrepancy might be possible: that the Greeks' knowledge of human nature lagged way behind the actual wealth of types and individuals: that they might have been only faintly

aware of their "humanity."

It is probably the case that never have so many different individuals gathered in such a small space and allowed themselves to perfect their peculiarities through competition. Yet if we examine the national peculiarities of their intellect: then it seems probable that their knowledge of human nature remained hampered. All their great powers worked to hamper this. This is my thesis.

Plato's unconstrained approach to Socrates (like his bust in Naples)

The unconstrained approach for coming to grips with Socrates (just like Xenophon)

in types, the decline of the individual (Homer Orpheus etc.)
 Antipathy toward exactness. Poetry far superior to history:
 the latter treats human beings in general, the former their
 par-
 ticularities. For that reason, poetry better suited for
 gaining
 knowledge of human beings. "The essential things repeat
 themselves, there is nothing new, there is no development" –
 this is authentically Greek. Absent is all reflection about dif-
 ferent futures. What do anachronisms matter! hundreds of
 characteristics fly at great persons and they stick.
 Conclusion. The whole Hellenic essence is deeper than sup-
 posed. Little can be done with testimonies. Historical
 facts,
 actions are more important, e.g., for their ethics, than all
 their
 words. We have yet to decipher the Hellenic essence: it is
 still
 essentially alien.

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we would offend their taste
 our knowledge of human nature shameless
 our technology tBgic*! opposed to nature
 our science petty-hucksterish
 untruthful, because so much about us is imperceptible II
 399.
 universal suffering of modern people: "self-diminution" p.
 399.

Drives of their intellect and their senses
 Drives and feelings from the political sphere
 the best developed instinct of their entire morality
 Introduction

- 1) The simplifying (they are so comprehensible), delight in overlooking secondary features, energy to make one feature the focus.
 - 2) The logicizing: a kind of enchantment (dialectic as something divine. Antigone's verse).
 - 3) The idealizing ("beautiful and young") the feeling that we satisfy in the great outdoors they satisfy among people.
 - 4) The feeling of nobility they* trusted themselves to determine correct self-worth
- II 397. Unfair to the humble. Nemesis: to

think oneself worthy of great things of which others are not worthy.

5) The atmosphere of political clarity, the necessity of making themselves commonly understood.

6) The agonal feeling that wants to triumph before an audience and that must be understandable by this audience. (Which is why such different individuals excessively profess to be “universally human.”

Judgment of the awakening “factual sense” as itself a consequence of the agon. Praise of Thucydides.

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In the mouth of a Greek it was paradoxical to claim to see the epitome of perfection in the sphere, they don't like curva-

ture and roundedness.

The feelings they have for nature are much more closely related to a religious sensibility than ours are. In our case, the

main thing is always that we are liberated from humans – we seek feelings that we do not have among humans.

I discovered what it means to be Greek: they believed in the eternal recurrence! This is the mystery-faith!

(passage in Cratylus)

Plato believes the dead in Hades are true philosophers, liberated from the body.

yv@d1 oavtón,® but not humans to read for subtext*4
nodove TAdtov, SniodEv te TAGtwv pécon te Xiparea.4

Purposes.

Their weakness points to their strength.

They are actors. For their intellect, willing and being converge.

8 [16] Superior humans, their self-redemption and self-preservation.

8 [17]

the appreciation of truth among the powerful (among the oppressed as revenge, vindication – Spinoza).

Self-overcoming of morality.

8 [18]

the preservation of the species reminted as moral principle!

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8 [x]*°

To completely emancipate absolute necessity from purposes: otherwise we may not even experiment and sacrifice ourselves and let ourselves go! It is the innocence of becoming*” and

nothing else that gives us the greatest courage and the
greatest
freedom!

8 [20]

I write for myself: and what's the point of writing in this
age

that has been written to death? little: for, apart from
scholars,

no one knows how to read anymore, and even scholars – – –

8 [21]

Our age has implanted new eyes in order to see suffering
everywhere: and with a monstrous hypnotic fixed gaze which
has had its equal just once before in history and which
forces

the gaze of beholders in the same direction – – –

When I was young, I was essentially one of the world-deniers
and pessimists; which is understandable and forgivable in an
age that seems tailor-made for driving youth to despair. The
more a young man suffers on account of his own becoming,
the more he wants to fit into the whole, complete and fin-
ished;

he wants security above all, stability: yet this age has
been

thought to death by the thoughts of all ages, it is mis-
trustful,

with a mistrust that has never yet existed among humans, and
for that reason this age is often tired of thinking, often
tired of

mistrusting, often senile and "tentative" in its yes and in
its no:

for this age presumes (a) yes in every case, where – – –

Here, then, the decisive protest of an individual like Scho-
penhauer against the whole of existence as a redemption: it
simplifies

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8 [22]

Every human being we meet stimulates certain drives in us
(fear trust etc.) Uninterrupted movement of our drive-life
through the outside world (nature): entirely apart from the
uninterrupted registering and absorption of electrical atmo-
spheric effects.

8 [23]*® good people"

Since every drive is unintelligent, "utility" is not a con-
sider-

ation for it at all. Every drive, by being active, sacri-
fices force

and other drives: it is eventually constrained; otherwise it would ruin everything, through dissipation. Thus: that which is "unegoistic" sacrificial imprudent is nothing special – it is common to all drives – they do not think about the benefit of the whole ego (because they don't think!) they act "contrary to our benefit," against the ego and often for the ego – innocent in both!

8 [24]°°

In philosophy we seek an image of the world that makes us feel freest; i.e., in which our most powerful drive feels free in its activity. This will be the case even with me!

8 [25]""

The nonsense of all metaphysics as a derivation of the conditioned from the unconditioned.

The nature of thinking includes conceiving, inventing the unconditioned as an addition to the conditioned: just as think-

ing conceives, invents the "I" as an addition to the multiplicity

of its processes: it measures the world with benchmarks posited solely by itself: in connection with its basic fictions like

"unconditioned," "means and ends," things, "substances," with logical laws, with numbers and shapes.

There would be nothing called knowledge if thinking had not first re-created the world into "things," self-identicals.

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It is due to thinking that there is untruth.

Thinking is underivable, so too are perceptions: but that is far

from proving them to be original or "existing in themselves"!

rather, this only establishes that we cannot get beyond them,

because we have nothing but thinking and perceiving.

8 [26]? The Innocence of Becoming."

A Guide to Liberation from Morality.4

By Friedrich Nietzsche.

Introduction.

I. The Fundamental Errors of Morality.

II. Morality as Sign Language.'

III. The Overcoming of Morality and its Replacement.

8 [276

Anyone who advances rationality thereby also infuses new energy into forces that oppose it, into mysticism and folly of every sort.

In every movement to distinguish

1) where it is partly fatigue from a preceding movement (satiation from it, malice of the weakness toward it, illness

2) where it is partly a newly awakened, long dormant, accumulated force, joyful, arrogant, violent: good health.

[9 = N VI 2. May-June 1883]

9 [x]

Your spring pours forth too mightily; it empties the cup at the same time it wants to fill it."

Peels and clamshells and whatever other playful things fall from the table of life?

Your good deeds should fall like dew on the grass, then, when the night is most secretive.*

I expect and want goodness especially from you, who I think is capable of any evil?

You should call advantage and need what advantage and need are and keep the name of virtue holy.

What makes your actions good is not their reason or purpose, but rather whether your soul trembles and shines when you do them.'

How could any act of mercy be performed if it did not mean: taking injustice upon ourselves?

If your shoulders are broad enough for the task, then don't hesitate, add the injustices of others to your own: and your mercy will be praised.

Knowing: this means: understanding all things as being to our best advantage!

"I will this," "thou shalt," "he must" – that's how they understand I you and he."

Experience approaches me imperiously: but no sooner has it been experienced than it is already on its knees.®

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Do you feel the thirst and the hot breath of the sun? It wants to be nursed by the ocean. Do you see the ocean's lust rise with a thousand breasts? It wants to be kissed and nursed

by the thirst of the sun?

9 [2]

To believe in Schopenhauer's will – this requires a very

strong will to believe! 9 [31°
 Midnight's brilliance was all around me, solitude looked at
 me with drunken tired eyes.
 – my voice screamed out of me –
 Deathly silence slept and snored'' in its sleep.
 There lay sleeplessness and midnight with drunken eyes.
 There lay solitude and deathly silence at its side: both
 slept
 and snored. 9 [4]? God stopgap.
 Onward to immortality
 9 [5]
 On the shame of the gift-giver.
 About justice (proletarians). On intoxication. The newer
 convents etc.
 Historical education – “I speak freely.”
 Honesty of the pitiable. Genius's!
 “Punishments” as enmity toward the enemies of our ideals.
 Temporary “marriage” –
 9 [6] slamming the door
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 how ridiculous it would be if you wanted to convert to my
 cause!'
 You come to me, and I don't want you: but as I must give, so
 you must take!
 “Party liner”!° – I want to turn this into an insult.
 I want to be a white steer and pull the plow: wherever I
 lie,
 there should be serenity and the earth should smell of
 earth.
 Wildly the eagle beats its wings: but its surge!” founders
 on
 my will.
 They no longer experience anything: their skin is barely
 scratched. Events sit on their skin like mosquitoes. – Thus
 h(umans) remain heavy and the same, like a stone in the sun.
 Church: simulated light, sweetened seriousness of the in-
 cense,
 being seduced into false fears, I can't stand the soul who –
 kneels to its God above.
 I looked into life as into an eye.
 Monk in the moon, you wet-cheeked one! Pll never call you
 the “man” in the moon! Lecherously you creep from window
 to window around all dark corners! you most jealous tomcat
 of all, jealous of all lovers, you grin through each window
 into
 the room within.

971"

They want to use their virtues to claw out the eyes of their enemies.

They engage in vice because they cannot create.

They — —

9 [8] The dances of Zarathustra.

9 [9]

I wanted to be the philosopher of unpleasant truths — for six years!

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9 [10]!

For too long I belonged to solitude: thus I have unlearned silence.

I have become nothing but mouth and the roar of a stream from high cliffs: I want to send my words cascading into the valleys.

I hate all nightwatchmen and guardians of the graves and anyone else who blows a dismal horn.

I long for something and I watch — and now you come, my eagle: did you see no one, — — —

I laugh at your free will and even at your unfree will: there

is no will. A delusion is born out of pain and contemplation — that's what we call "will."

9 [11]?°

I look down into the ocean: it lies placidly and out of it an

image looks treacherously back at me.

In its arms the ocean holds a priceless image with white breasts: it steals languidly and treacherously across the sand,

so that — — —

in this way, ocean and an image of the future lure me

Languidly and treacherously the ocean moved away from its white breasts.

The sand has covered half the image and the jealousy of the wave the other half.

9 [12]

Determinism is to be eliminated in this way:

I want to submit myself to the judgment of certain h(umans): it should be my education, spur me on and discourage me — all

as a means of getting an ideal to prevail and making it dominant.

Organic = moral, is the solution to the problem of morality. Initially, individuals are honored insofar as they evoke a

type: e.g., "the priest," "the hero" etc. – only later, in-
sofar as

they are "a person alone."

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There are moralities which make a virtue out of becoming
not an individual, but rather a type! finally, becoming one
in

feeling with a revered type of the people.

9 [1a]?!

The ring's thirst to reach itse/fagain – I thirst for it.??

9 [14]?

Your minds were not yet a source of worry and heartache:
your bread of life is not yet soured by thoughts.

As a hunter Zarathustra set forth, to hunt ugly truths.

The hand moved forward and the clock of my life) took a
breath: then it spoke: now the hour has come to preach
redemption from redeemers.

9 [15]

How I sought to understand everything that is human, at
one point even wretched and mediocre people

Now and then even the wretched become honest: then it is
advisable to listen to their voices and to climb into their
swamp.

And at one point I, too, sat down among the reeds and
heard the frogs of wretchedness make their confessions.

You people claim to be of sturdier stuff? I say to you, you
are only better at deluding yourselves.

He came to us, he lived among us – we ourselves were his
underworld.

Believe me, Zarathustra) died and is no more. A star
burned out in barren space: but its light – – *

9 [16]

Destroy for me these godly grinning masks! was I made to
play the fool by a godly grin and did (I) forget the en-
trails

with which the masks were stuffed?

Rip up for me the skins on which a god's soul seemed to
play!

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Serpent entrails and serpent filth ooze from the hidden
body of the lizard: the coiled-up ringed putrid-smelling
thing

a horrid ringed worm has crept into the mask of a god.

holy laughter

9.117)

You see only my sparks: but you do not see the anvil that I

am.

And I prefer to sleep on ox hides than on the bed of your complacency and love, — — —

You are tools and watches to me: thus I want to wind you up with my ridicule and you shall purr with contentment as I do it.

I do not want to turn you into stone with serpent locks of fear: I protect myself from you with my shield "Beauty." My image of the most beautiful shall strike you dumb.

I do battle with the dragon of the future: and you puny people, you shall do battle with earthworms.

9 [18]

You are adept and have clever fingers: but you have no idea how to make a fist!

Not until your clever fingers creep back into a fist will I want to believe in your power."

His eye flashes golden: a golden bark"® floats there upon dark waters:"?

In his eyes (he) crouches low and leaps high again in dance and you, who carry him — — —

To me you are arid grass and steppe: but I want to make wildfires of you and heralds with tongues of flame.°*°

When this moon rose, I thought that it wanted to give birth to a sun: it lay there on the horizon so wide and heavy with young.

But to me the moon is a liar, this barren one, with its preg-

nancy, and it is neither woman nor man.?!

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9 [r]

a strange cock, pecked at by hens"

he rose like a moon, but stayed lying languidly on the horizon.?

Anyone who knows horses also knows what it means to be in the saddle.*

9 zo)"

Did I cause you the greatest pain when I did what I liked to do the most?

I did penance for my injustice: my admiration was even more unjust than my contempt.3°

With vigils I did penance for the admirer's 1000 lies and for

his eye's desire to be blind.

With 1000 acts of evil I took revenge on all prettification and nonsensical fantasy.

I despise you oblivious liars far more than I despise those

who know they lie.

Because you lie about the way things are, no thirst will emerge within you for the way things ought to be.

9 [21]?7

they were choking on their nothingness: I gave them their nothingness to feed on.

They were rotting away at the sight of themselves: I held up my mirror to their ugliness

Just as they perished from their own nothingness and were unable to bear the sight of themselves, they experienced their

highest moment.

And I would need gloves of glass in order to poison you.

9 [22]

La vie est une tragédie pour ceux qui sentent, et une comédie

pour ceux, qui pensent.*® Horace Walpole.

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9 [23]?

You don't want to hear that someone is strolling around above your heads. And so you place wood and earth and refuse above your heads: that's how you muffle the speech of my steps. You put all human error and obtuseness between yourselves and me: you call this a dead floor in your houses.

But in spite of this I stroll around above your thoughts, and

they themselves should stroll around on top of my mistakes.

You shame yourselves with broad stairways for those who would rise like gods: and as the arches break above you and play off against each other — — —

you put your longing into the mouth of the faraway moon:

your longing stretched beyond the words and above as well!

Whatever contradicted them they called God: their kind of

heroism, to destroy what is human within them in this way:

but the time is past for human beings to nail themselves to the

cross.

All those who create seek new languages: they have grown tired of their thin used-up tongues: the mind has been walking on these soles for far too long.

As long as beauty is not one of your needs, what do I care about your obsession with the beautiful!

Not satisfaction, but rather beauty, should be the end of desire

The way you are, you are only to be tolerated as ruins: and

that which destroys you, lightning and downpours and weeds:
your unhappiness and adversity justify your existence.
You must learn to build with mountains: merely removing
mountains" means little.

Your sayings – "puny truths" near the swamps: and some
cold frog is sitting in there.

9 al"

May my eagle always be a danger to small white sheep and
be known as a raptor!

314 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Are you familiar with the terror of people falling asleep?
They are shaken to the depths of their being, for the dream
is

beginning – and often their terror shakes them awake.

Your virtue should serve and honor only that for which you
despise yourselves the most. This alone should be the ser-
vice

and the benefit provided by your virtue!

What are your father- and motherlands to me? I love only
my children's land, through my children I wish to make up
for

the fact that I am my father's child.

I wanted to catch a fish and threw a net into the sea – but
I drew forth a god's head instead: the sea gave me, the
hungry

one, a stone.

nature is a divine puppet show.

ashes and embers blow upon me

wildfire

dry grass

crackling

9 [25]

Many things must come together for a moral action

1) a strong spontaneity

2) the most extreme tension of the willing I

it is the highest form of organic functions.

9 261% 43

I also demand grace' even from those inclined to greatness.

9 [27]

the Dionysian as the aspect of antiquity that is most ac-
cessi-

ble for me.

9 [28] Genius and bungling

9 [29]* Corsica and Italy.

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Democracy as decline of the state.

Taking away the Jews' money and giving them another direction.

the Dionysian as access to the Greeks.

an enormous mass of lofty feelings, for which thoughts are still lacking and goals

to raise humans above themselves, as with the Greeks, not disembodied phantasms.

9 [30]®

Your Great Flood still oppresses the earth

I come from there like a strong wind and that's why I advise those who despise me: when facing the wind, be careful not to

– spit.

The monster of the body has scarcely raised itself out of the

darkest slime

I call this festival the cleansing and sanctification of the earth

to be your only contemporary!

You want to sap the strength of sickness and, for me, in the process you are sapping the strength of the sick, you witch doctors and saviors!

Whenever those who could command attempt to persuade and hide their kingly hands beneath their robes: I call this courtesy.

My savage wisdom got pregnant atop lonely mountains: it brought forth its young on bare stone. Now it runs foolishly through the harsh desert and seeks soft grass for its youngest,

my old savage wisdom.

9 [5146

I believed myself to be the richest one of all: now I have made a gift of myself.

I do not even touch their souls' skin anymore!

316 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Ever more solitary and exiled: ever more ardent in love and wanting to go among the people.

The 7 solitudes.

All typical sufferings of the reformers; and their consolations.

1) Consolation: I will lay my hand on the next millennium.

2) I live as if I were living in another age: my eminence gives

me contact with solitary and misunderstood people in all age(s)

3) I do not hate I defend myself with beauty.

9 [32]

With many small doses it is possible to turn a brave man into a coward: but also a coward into a brave man.

Cosmic dependence

Pass by these enemies quietly and with a sleeping sword: those who attack them sully themselves.

Like the buffalo I live near the sea and even nearer to the forest.

9 [33]

Drives should be denied as long as possible – principle of moral-physiological) research.

Whatever makes us value a human being now has always done so. H(uman beings) came to be honored first and only then actions“

9 (34)?

How would I endure it if I didn't love superhumans more than you?

For what purpose did I give you the 100-faceted mirror?

I also overcame love for you with love for superhumans.

And as I endure you, you must endure yourselves, out of love for s(uperhumans).

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For me, you are the stone in which the most sublime of all statues sleeps

And as my hammer swings at you, you should swing at yourselves for my sake: the call of the hammer should awaken the sleeping statue.

People who wanted to conceal themselves, and were shamed by the clear sky, created for themselves these sweet-smelling caves.

I do not want to become enamored again of these places until grass and red poppies flourish on ruined walls.

9 [35]? Dirges at the volcano's edge Nature's stillness – thunder.

Golden casket.

9 [36]

§ Redemption from redeemers is what Zarathustra teaches.

P

§ generous to the earth? no, just.

§ “I acquit: for I also would have acted in the very same

q y

way” – a ghastly historic formulation! it means “I am tolerant

of myself – consequently!”

“Thou shalt? I will this”

9 [37]

Every time I put on a good pair of glasses, I am amazed at how ugly h(umans) are and how anyone could stand to be around them.

9 [38]

The meaning of causality becomes ever weaker when looking backwards (e.g., myths) Consequently conceptions about what is inner must be especially lacking in reason.

The oldest assumptions must be the dumbest

318 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

9 [39]

"Will" is a concept for unifying all of our passions.

Passions are feelings for identifying particular bodily states

that are not attributable to the body.

"Common feelings"

Moral feelings are passions transformed by value judgments.

The influence of judgment on feeling (even with pleasure and pain)

Pleasure and pain are value judgments

9 [40]

How superficial and impoverished is everything that is inner:

e.g., purpose (image of chewing and actual chewing)

e.g., a concept of horse in comparison to a horse,

e.g., the feeling of warmth in comparison to what happens

e.g., the I in comparison to the "self"

e.g. seeing in comparison to the mechanics of seeing,

e.g. the feeling of a heartbeat in comparison to its mechanics

9 [41]

There are only bodily states: mental states are consequences and symbolism.

To separate outer and inner world, as metaphysicians do, is already a sensory judgment.

Eye ear are also "outer world."

Feelings and the outer world are given to us: and even the feelings localized in this world.

I call all sense impressions "stimuli."

" . »

"Illusion" only makes sense for the eye.

To show "the metaphysics of metaphysics"!

We are in the process of figuring out the being of things: consequently we must already have an opinion as to what being

is. This can be an error! e.g., I.

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9 [42]

The silliness of morality in its assessment of value according to difficulty.

The "inner world" is much thinner and shorter than the mechanical world. Overestimation!

Unegoistic acts as self-deception and shortsightedness. "Shortcut"

Purification of the inner world.

At some point religious aesthetic and moral attitudes must have been one and the same.

Designation and valuation of our bodily states – how to do it?

9 [43]

I had to abolish morality in order to have my moral will prevail.

Supposing morality is valid, then I must not overwhelm my neighbors with the power of my judging. So I also must not terrorize (unnerve) them

Yes, they are innocent

Struggle for power! To make my ideal prevail in a manner derived from my ideal!

Human actions can in no way be explained by reference to human motives.

Individuals continue to have an effect inside their impulses.

The superior intellect bound to a weak nervous character – is to be eliminated.

Contempt for the accumulation and influence of power runs counter to the principle of the organic.

320 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

9 [44]

2. Measures of value (the scientific measure lacking up to now)

Herds and individuals.

Fear or hope accompany a feeling of pain or pleasure – as with all passions.

Anger (and all affects) initially a bodily state: which is interpreted. Later the interpretation freely generates the state.

3 9 [45]°

not necessary and not even superfluous

they shoot off their mouths; we are supposed to think that this is out of the abundance of their hearts.°4

A star went under and disappeared – but its light is still
 on
 its way, and when will it cease being on its way?
 Are you a star? Then you, too, must wander and be homeless.
 § The murder-of-God-penitents and their festival'
 You have yet to be taught Aunger for your knowledge.
 Dancers have their ears in their toes.
 It is also sweet to resist ourselves and to comb back the
 hair
 of bushy feelings.
 § to wean h(uman beings) from feelings of "punishment"
 and "guilt"
 9 MAY-JUNE 1883 321
 9 [46]
 Everything organic must be overcome. Little and often!
 How could I want to live if I did not look ahead – beyond
 you!
 Fear the one who has withdrawn! The tiger prepares to
 spring!"
 Reverence is itself a passion: just like verbal abuse.
 Through
 P J g
 reverence the "passions" were turned into virtues.
 I can only rarely recall an unconditional "should": thus no
 > «
 authority! Kant's "moral sense" is nothing! This is the van-
 ity
 that wants one "should" to be the "should" for all the
 world!
 9 [47]
 Corporations – apart from the state.
 Our thoughts come as stimuli from somewhere. (Nothing
 to do with "pleasant" and "unpleasant.")
 In the weak, I appraise the good and bad alike.
 Stronger people as nobler people.
 For the education of individuals.
 Workers should for once live like the bourgeois now live:
 but above them the higher caste, distinguishing themselves
 through lack of needs! thus poorer and simpler, yet in
 posses-
 sion of power'?
 Right to design your own entirely individual approach to
 punishment.
 322 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS
 If you do not want to advocate the individuum in what most
 belongs to you, but rather to contradict it, then the con-

tradic-

tion is part of the individual "responsibility" –

9 [48]

The most influential people are the most hidden.

Culture is just a thin apple skin over a glowing chaos.

People nor equal: thus speaks justice.

Not utility but gravitas determines value: a noble person is the result of much labor.

Individuum est aliquid novum:®! actions are not shared in common with anyone.

The® will a delusion.

The truth hurts because it destroys a belief: not in itself.

Inventors of new states of the soul are the true inventors: people seek to mimic these states"

Dühring: no one would wish for such a bitter soul. That is why his philosophy is not attractive.

Feeling of power. – Happiness is not the goal: but rather a monstrous force in humans and in humankind wants to expend itself, wants to create, it is an ongoing chain of explosions

that in no way have happiness as the goal.

So you want to be paid?

"like a sweet smell" – but she had to die.

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9 [a]

Purification from revenge is my morality. §

"When has such a flame ever burned? (as Zarathustra)

I hate anyone who limps along in front of us.

Those who walk forward with their heads turned backward –

The ocean that delights in spreading its peacock train upon soft sand.

[50] § the proletarian ("Dühring")

§ Intoxication. Its common form in convulsive atonement.

Warn about Dionysus!

9 [51]

Within different people we find the same number of passions: yet these are given different names, evaluated differently

and in the process adjudicated differently. Good and evil are

distinguished by the differing orders of rank of passions as they relate to one another and by the dominance of goals.

9 [s]®

You think everything is the wild play of giants? Yet a single

word, arriving on the wings of doves, directs the will of

these

wild ones: The still source 9 [53] It is night –now
all gushing fountains speak more loudly
– and you, too, my soul
are a gushing fountain.

It is night – and all songs of those who love
just now awaken.

And you, too, my soul, are
the song of someone who loves.⁶⁷

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9 [54]

Incense of someone being burned at the stake.

9 [55]

The very best knowledge[®] is barely sufficient for faith.

9 [56][®]

–the dream

–proletarians

–intoxication. Its most common form in convulsions of
conscience

–redemption from redeemers

– I acquit: for I also would have done the same thing.”

–generous to the earth? no, just!

–Do you want to be paid?

–Annihilation and resurrection of morality.

9 [57]

Daniel Darc, bréviaire du Parisien (Ollendorf éditeur)[°]

Brehm Moldenhauer

9 [58]

Collection of sublime states and objects.

9 [59]

No. 343 M(ixed) O(pinions) and M(axims)

[10 = N VI 3. June-July 1883]

10 [1]!

by striving upward against my burden, I rejuvenated myself:
and just when I became more hardened within myself, I
learned

grace, too.

inventive in small stratagems and lusting for buyers, they
waited: with emaciated souls and meager in hope.

10 [2]?

My stream threw itself wildly in wrong directions and into
impassable canyons: but how should it ever come about that a
stream failed to reach the ocean?

I found a lake, a hermit and a self-satisfied person: but my
stream threw itself into this lake (and) swept it along into
the

ocean.
 10 [3]?
 like Caesar. immovable.
 You don't know me
 I gave you the heaviest burden – so that the weaklings would
 perish from it – for breeding.
 No compassion!
 I want to form and transform myself and you
 how would I bear it otherwise!*
 when my I? dreamed you
 326 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS
 10 [4]°
 Pity the humans and superhumans who do not have a pin-
 nacle that is even above compassion!
 The smallest gap stands between me and you: but who has
 ever built bridges across the smallest gaps!
 Conversation with the hound of hell.' (volcano)
 On ashes I stride up the mountain of ashes at dusk: my
 shadow grows long and longer.
 A boat floats far away in the violet-blue sea: the sailor
 who
 sees me striding along crosses himself
 Now Zarathustra is journeying to hell – he says, shudder-
 ing: I had always figured it would end this way!
 You are completely wrong, fisherman! The devil is not taking
 me: instead, Zarathustra is now taking the devil as his
 own.®
 10 [5]?
 your knees worship, but your heart knows nothing of it.
 to bring redemption
 There lies the island of tombs, there, too, the tombs of my
 youth: I want to carry an evergreen wreath of life there.
 I thought of my youth today I walked up my street of tombs
 I sat on ruins between red poppies and grass – on my own
 ruins.
 traveling to the island of the departed on sleeping seas
 You still live, old patient heart of iron: and in you, too,
 what
 is unredeemed, unspoken from my youth, still lives.
 10 [6]!°
 Jesus – like a sweet smell.
 The preservation of the species is guaranteed: but what does
 it involve!
 10 JUNE-JULY 1883 327
 Redeemers
 Philosophers. Those who know. Scientists. Genius

Free spirits.

Romantics.

Artists.

Conquerors "strong willed" mocked Statesmen

Saints:

Fidelity Truthfulness Compassion. Justice.

Bravery Obedience.

And if you aren't a bird, be careful not to camp above an abyss.

I can no longer descend to you: my eye itself blurs and becomes

blind to the upward path that I traveled.

10 [7]

The art of the tarantula is black and blackening: yet I call tarantulas the teachers of the "worst world"

10 [8]!?

I had renounced life: I had become nightwatchman and

guardian of the graves in death's mountain fortress.

Up there I guarded his coffins in musty vaults: they stood full of such victory emblems: life that had been overcome stared at me from glass coffins.

I myself am like the wind that shatters the gates to the chambers of the dead. I myself am like the coffin filled with

colorful malicious words and angeli(c) grimaces, I myself am the laughter of life in the midnight chamber of the dead!°

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10 [9]!4

one person rejoices that justice still includes taking revenge:

and another person rejoices that revenge still means that justice is being done. (Dühring and the Corsican')

If there were gods: how could I stand not being a god! But there are no gods. 10 [ro]!°

Long ago, this happened to me: I dreamed my most burdensome dream, and while dreaming I composed my darkest riddle.

But, behold, my life itself interpreted this dream. Behold, my today redeemed my yesterday and the meaning imprisoned within.

And so, too, this happened recently: thunder boomed three times through the night in my direction, the vaults howled three times.

Alpa, I called, Alpa, Alpa. W(ho) (is) c(arrying) (his) a(shes)

t(o) (the) m(ountain)? Which of those lives that have been
overcome approaches me, the nightwa(tchman) and guardian
of graves?

When I dreamed you, I dr(eamed) my most burdensome dream.
This is why I want to be your horror – your fainting and
your awakening.

10 [11]'7 Praise of Cool Reason

the one who creates praises poverty of the intellect and
skepticism sweet smell midsummer

18

The courage to demand the extraord(inary) is rarer than the
courage to achieve it.

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Strength and duration of resolve and frugality (insight into
earthly imperf(ection)

10 [12]!?

Sweet and stale like the smell of aging virgins? you schol-
ars.

You redeemers, what do you know of human beings!

And why don't you want to make yourselves into bait –
alongside me?

But no voice responded.

Alas, you do not know how much I, a solitary man, am
comfortable with human voices which a wind or a bird carried
to me. I have even gotten drunk on ugly voices.

Alpa! I screamed, so let your voice be heard already. Alpa!
my fear and longing screamed forth from me.

10 [13]

How easy it is for us to take on the burden of an apol(ogy),
as long as there is no responsibility.

But I am responsible.

10 [14]?!

You compassionate ones, when you throw yourselves from
the heights at the people below, what price do you put on
bro-

ken limbs!

10 [15]??

But there was silence, terrible silence redoubled. Alas, you
are not familiar with it, the redoubled silence, the one
that ties

our hearts in knots!

Alpa! I screamed. Alpa! Alpa! The fear of redoubled silence
screamed forth from me.

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10 [16]?3

Stooped over, working in dim gloomy shafts, this is the

prisoners' hardest lot.

10 [17]

Where did he go? Who knows?

But it is certain that he met his downfall.

A star burned out in barren space."4

The intransitory – this is only a symbol, and poets lie too much."

They also know too little and are bad learners: so they must already be lying.

And what is most dear to them is the kingdom in the clouds: they enthrone their colorful brats up there and call them gods,

And when they lie in a garden under trees or give speeches by themselves in front of the flowers by a precipice, then they

think that their tend(er) feel(ings) are knowledge.

They all believe that nature is in love with them and are always listening in to its accolades.

10 [18]?°

Dare to believe in yourselves no matter what! How else should anyone believe in you otherwise! Those who do not believe in themselves are always lying!

Willing liberates! – thus do I teach you freedom (of) t(he) will

10 [19]

This laughter shattered me, and ripped apart my guts, and slit open my heart.

Strong will? An enduring will is what I need, a hard-hearted eternal resoluteness.

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10 [20]8

All creation is transformation – and wherever creative hands are working there are many deaths and downfalls.

And only this is dying and disintegration: without pity sculptors hammer away at the marble.

That they may free the sleeping image from the stone, this is

why they must be without pity: – this is why we must all suffer and die and turn to dust.

But we ourselves are the sculptors, serving the sculptor's eye: we ourselves often tremble at the creative savagery of our hands.

10 [21]"?

Who among you poets has not adulterated his wines? Many a poisonous mishmash lies hidden in your cellars.

Do you want to see the rainbow and the bridge of the
superhumans? Right now is the time.
The storm cloud is still rumbling, but already the sun
shines
again.

10 [22]?° Prophecy.

Someday I will have my summer: and it will be like a summer
in the high mountains.

A summer near the snow, near eagles, near death.

10 [23]?

This is the most unforgiveable thing about you: you have
the power and you don't want to rule.

You see, don't you, the one they all need the most. This is
the one who can command. Will – – –

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10 [24]

You have hungry minds: so take this truth quickly from me
as a snack: the intransitory – this is only a symbol.

10 [25]

superhumans completely beyond all previous virtue, hard-
hearted due to their compassion, – those who create, who
unsparingly hammer their marble. For Zarathustra's last
speech.

10 [26]

To play the great game – to wager the existence of human-
kind on the poss(ibility) of achieving something higher than
the preservation of the species.

F(or the) Kast) spee(ch)

10 [27]

I will reach you late – just as the Greek artists are reach-
ing

you only now.

Aesch(ylus)

10 [28]?

Conversation with the hound of fire

Mockery of his pathos against the revolution

10 [29]

Mockery of revolutions and Vesuviuses. Something from
the surface

10 [30]}°4

You are not yet driven by any strong wind or will

You are still too stiff for me and your neck is too stiff"

Alas, that you would walk across the sea, already full and
rounded like a sail, trembling in the storminess of your
will!

Only then shall I call you beautiful and properly prepared!

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10 [31]?°

These are heated times right now, the air is on fire – now everyone is walking around naked, good and evil people! this world without clothes is a festival for those who know.

States burst apart

Earthquakes

everything becomes visible

Taine?"

What makes the earth quake: the silent words of the saints
Storm of malice.

Rejoicing that everything is becoming visible and bursting.
I feel so wonderful!

End of all customs and secret dealings.

Twilight of the gods –*8

There is nothing eternal!

10 [32]?

Deep knowledge flows cold, its deepest wellsprings are ice-cold: that's why it is refreshing to hot hands and to anyone eager for action.

10 [33]*°

I love the turbulence of a bad reputation, like a ship, the wake that the ship creates. I tread more lightly, when the way

around my keel – – –

10 [34]*!

But just as I was awakened by you and came to myself, so you, too, should be awakened by yourselves – and come to me! Redeemers? I call you the ones who bind and tame!
to approach the wellspring with humble hands

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ro [35]?

Truly, I say to you: wherever there are tombs, there have also always been resurrections!

Speak your word" and founder on it. What do you matter!

10 [36]

I am well-disposed to all that is pure:

I say to you, mediators and equivocators, to you half-and-halfers: you are not pure

how could I be well disposed to you conciliators!

10 [37]%

There haven't been any superhumans yet. I saw them both naked, the greatest and the puniest humans: and I found both of them still – all too human!

10 [38]°

You play and you want your play to be watched – I call all

of you actors.

Whether you call yourselves poets or dancers or public servants and the voice of the people –

Whether you teach or paint or compose or play “Black on White”: – you want to make a name for yourselves.

Mother Vanity

The opposite of those who would like to erase their names and stick their heads in the sand – so that their task will not

see them and will pass them by.

10 [39]

and only when I am a burden to myself, do you weigh heavily on me.

10 [40]*

1 Laughing at the ethical world-order. “paid for”

2 Dance song

10 JUNE-JULY 1883

3 Dream.

4 Hound of fire

5 Mediators.

6 Praise of cool reason

7 Penitents of the mind.

8 Many societies (to the conquerors = founders)

9 Poets geniuses actors

10 Scholars

11 to stroll among fragments! 12 Philosophers

13 Socialists for equality

14 Those who speak freely *

15 Pessimists

10 [41]? On the Hucksters the Curious Frugal (Mystics) on the Vanity of the Pure

On the Sculptors of Idols. On Necromancers Free-speech advocates. Reconcilers. Mediators

There haven't been any superhumans yet.

10 [42]?°

Pleasure of the mistral wind of the plowshare of the heights of life

of the change in seasons (ring) Organic

of the stream of the dawn of the clear sky electricity.

Pleasure as mother of pain.

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10 [43]

Main doctrine: nature is like a human being: errs etc.

Anthropomorphizing of nature.

10 [44]

Therefore, I conclude, a belief in time is good for our

health.

(pessimists last of all)

There are three solitudes: that of the one who creates, that of the one who waits and that of shame.

I know the word and the sign of the superhumans: but I do not show it, I do not show it to myself.

What did you do? ("Festival of Life") – – "This is how things are, coming from the mind of Zarathustra"

The doctrine first called good by the rabble, in the end called good by the most superior humans.

We want to live like Z(arathustra), ashamed in the face of a great truth.

10 [45]"

Act I. The temptations. He does not consider himself ripe.

(Chosen people)

Solitude on account of being ashamed of himself

Act II. Zarathustra attending the "great noon" incognito

Is recognized

Act III. Catastrophe: everyone abandons him after his speech.

He dies from the pain. Act IV. Funeral rites "We killed him" countering the arguments

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10 [46]

Concerning 1). He refuses. Finally the children's choirs bring

him to tears.

A fool!

2 kings lead the donkey.

Concerning 2) When the procession does not know where to turn, the messengers arrive from the plague city. Decision.

As

in the forest. Fire in the marketplace symbol{ic) purification.

Destruction of the dig city the end

I want to lead the pious astray.

10 [47]

Zarathustra sitting in the ruins of a church Act 4

the gentlest person must become the most hard-hearted person – and perish in the process?

Gentle to humans, hard-hearted for the sake of superhumans

Collision.

apparent weakness.

he prophesies to them: the doctrine of return is the sign.

He forgets himself and teaches return as derived from the superhumans: the superhumans withstand the doctrine and use

it to punish.

As he returns from his vision, he dies from it

[11 = N VI 4. June-July 1883]

u [1] sleepless agony, bleeding

u [2]! On Scholars. On the Land of Education. On the Rabble.
The Funeral Rites.

u [3]

Which of the two of us is the bigger fool?

Zarathustra answered: the one of us who thinks that of the
other.

What is the most fertile mother of tragedies?

Wounded vanity."

Which of the two of us is the happiest?

(The one) whose unhappiness has gone wrong in the best
way.

This is my abyss and my danger, that I plummet into these
heights – and certainly not into your depths!

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u [4]

Let's see whether or not the lioness is learning to roar
gently!

Alas, if only I knew how to lure you back to me with shep-
herds' flutes! Alas, if only the lioness would learn to roar
gently!

u [5]

Frustration at the fact that necessity is iron and that the
ret-

roactive will is denied to us:

Rage at the fact that time flows away into the future and
does not allow itself to be forced into the mill of the
past!

That something suffers, refreshes us –: this is our most an-
cient
folly.

u [6]

W(agner) turns to those who are made mistrustful by argu-
ments but are convinced by sublime gestures.

u [7]

I never take people completely seriously. My enemies don't
have to make a lot of amends to me because it's too easy for
me

to start laughing at them. But I could easily kill on im-
pulse.

1 [8]?

There is something fundamentally flawed in human beings
– they must be overcome. Attempt it!

11 [9]°

Dühring. He is satisfied when he has added a few angry and arrogant words: that's what he calls "witty"

u [10]® II Zarathustra includes: the Penitent of the Mind
The Murderer of God.' weary people The Beehives

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u [x]

When the house is burning, even dinner is forgotten –
said the hound of fire.

Yes, and the hound finishes it later amidst the ashes.®

u [12]

This is true virtue, which does not know about itself – this
is how you taught me the doctrine.

ever since then, I have found true modesty on heaths and
hedges and everywhere:

everywhere it grows like huckleberries, where nothing else
grows that is good.

u [13]? a The Funeral Rites

b On the Hound of Fire

c the stillest hour

u [14]

With every action a lot is accomplished that we don't think
about.

rr [15]!°

Your will is still too proud and timid. If you want to have
good –

They will build beehives like Towers of Babel.

u [16]!

And may everything shatter that can be shattered by our
truths! There are still many worlds to build!

u [17]? On the Rabble On Tarantulas the pro(phet) The Funer-
al Rites

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u [18] Ill Humor of the Gift-Giver On Good and Evil. Conver-
sation with the King On Great Events The Stillest Hour

u [19]

Victory over the spirit of gravity

11 [20]

an architectural style for this soul

u [21]

strange saints are coming along, one by one, even a fool.

[12 = Z I 3. Summer 1883]

"Wicked Wisdom." Maxims and Mottos by Friedrich Nietzsche.

Barbs. Maxims and Mottos by Friedrich Nietzsche.

2. Convictions are more dangerous enemies of truth than are
lies.

3. Many people are stubborn in regard to a path once they have entered upon it, few in regard to the goal.*
4. The serpent must first become a dragon so that someone can become a hero against it.'
5. Not to speak of ourselves at all is a very refined form of
– hypocrisy.°
- 1 SUMMER 1883 343
6. Truth is least likely to find advocates, not when it is dangerous to speak the truth – but when it is boring to do so."
7. We are so glad to be out amid nature because it has no opinion about us.®
8. The irrationality of a thing is no argument against its existence, but rather a condition for it?
9. The iron necessity of which people speak is usually neither iron, nor necessary.!
10. When we have a lot to put into it, a day has a hundred pockers.!!
11. Anyone who hears poorly always hears something more.!??
12. We are in the most danger of being run over when we have just gotten out of the way of some vehicle."
13. Waiting makes people immoral.'*
15. The advantage of a bad memory is that we can enjoy the same good things for the first time many times.!!°
17. A marriage proves its worth by being able to put up with an occasional deviation.'?
bored.!??

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20. Some men have sighed over the abduction of their wives, many more because nobody wanted to abduct them."°
21. It is doubtful whether a much-traveled person will have found any parts of the world uglier than those in the human face.?!?
22. We persuade courageous people to undertake some action by representing it as more dangerous than it is.??
23. The best means of coming to the assistance of people who are embarrassed is to praise them with conviction."
24. We can speak very much to the point and yet in such a way that everyone in the world shouts the opposite: when, that
is, we are not speaking to everyone in the world."
25. The visionaries deny the truth to themselves, the liars only

to others."

what mattered to the tree; but what mattered to it was the
26 seed.

27. Anyone who has seen someone's ideal is that person's
unrelenting judge and guilty conscience as it were.""

28. The followers of a great man like to blind themselves in
order

to be better able to sing his praises better: poor song-
birds! ?8

29. What is genius? Wanting both a lofty goal and the means
for attaining it.??

30. What is bad gains prestige through imitation, what is
good

loses it, especially in art.*°

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31. We must know how to dim our lights in order to get rid
of

mosquitoes and admirers.?!

32. That you are trying to identify the exceptions ranks you
far below someone else, especially when that person is try-
ing

to identify the rule.*?

33. Every master has only one pupil: a pupil who will be
unfaithful to just that master. For that pupil is also
destined

for mastery.??

34. It says nothing against the ripeness of a spirit"? that
it has
a few worms.'

35. In solitude, solitary people consume themselves, amid
mul-

titudes, they are consumed by many. Now choose.?°

36. Differently from a journeyman does a master love the
master.>"

37. We won't get the crowd to cry hosannas until we ride
into

town on an ass.'®

38. Our supporters never forgive us if we take sides against
ourselves.??

39. Women are the idleness of the creator on every seventh
day.

40. We must take care not to become prematurely sharp, be-
cause

then we become prematurely – dull.

41. Anyone we leave standing for a long time in the anteroom
of our favor begins to ferment and becomes sour.4?

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44. A good maxim is too hard even for the teeth of time."

45. A good book enriches even the spirits*® of its opponents.'" "

48. What has to be given to you in pieces need not be fragmentary for that reason."°

49. Good ideas that follow too quickly after one another block each other's "view."?!

50. Self-sacrifice is present in every action, in the best as well as in the worst.>"

51. Whether we have a serpent's tooth is something that we do

not know until someone has put their heel upon us.

52. Those who find even one grain of humiliation in a sack of

advantages that have been given to them will still make the worst of a good thing.*4

53. We know a little too much about everyone.*°

56

ss. Still better to wash with dirty water than to remain unclean.*"

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57. We should remove the scaffolding once the house has been built.5?

59. The most dangerous supporter is the one whose defection would annihilate the entire party – hence the best supporter.°!

61. People press toward the light, not in order to see better, but in order to shine more brightly.

62. Before we "go looking for the right person," we must have found the lantern.°*

64. The style that has been found is a pain in the ear to any

friend of the style that has been sought.

65. When virtue has slept, it will arise refreshed."

68

67. Scoundrels are not to be sought among law-breakers but rather among those who do not "break" anything."

69. Antithesis is the narrow gate through which error prefers

to creep toward truth."!

70. With one talent more, we stand less secure than with one fewer.'?

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72. "Should a band not tear loose – you must try biting into
27475 it.

73. The higher we soar, the smaller we appear to those who
cannot fly."

74. How good bad music and bad arguments sound when we
march off after an enemy!'7

75. Part of the masters' mastery is warning their pupils
about
themselves."

76. Why don't people see things? They themselves are stand-
ing in their own way: they cover up things.'

77. Those who want to kill their enemies should consider
whether this act will immortalize their enemies for them.

78. In most cases, the best cure for love is still that age-
old

radical medicine: requited love.®!

79. Some people have the greatest right to act in such and
such a manner. But once they start defending that right, we
no longer believe in it.®?

80. For people in need of solace no means of receiving it is
more comforting than the assertion that for their situation
there is no solace.®3

81. Lively natures lie for only an instant: afterwards they
lie to

themselves and are convinced and upright.*4

82. To rush into the midst of the enemy can be a sign of
fear

and cowardice.®°

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83. Fearful people don't know what it means to be alone: en-
emies

are always standing behind their chairs.*°

84. We no longer want to turn the causes into sinners and
the

consequences into executioners.®"

85. We ought to do away with beggars: for we feel annoyed
giving to them and annoyed when we don't.®®

86. Scholars: this is what the soldiers of the mind are
called

today, as are – unfortunately – also those who darn the
socks of the mind. ®?

87. It is the heart that inspires: and it is the mind that
heartens

us and keeps us cool when we are in danger. Oh language"?

88. We lie with our tongues but we still tell the truth with

our

mouths and maws.?!

89. Humans are the animals with red cheeks: humans are the animals that have often had to feel ashamed of themselves.??

go. Talking a lot about ourselves is also a means of concealing

ourselves."

91. You believe, so you claim, in the necessity of religion? Be

honest! You believe only in the necessity of police.?*

92. Women? are more sensual than men, but they know less about their sensuality.?°

93. Morality is human posturing in the face of nature.""

we are praising our taste: doesn't this go against all good taste??®

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95. There are no h(umans) at all: for there was no first h(uman)

– this is how animals make inferences."?

96. God, too, has his hell, said the devil: this is his love for

humans.!0°

97. Those who attain their ideal are thereby already – transcending it.!0!

98. Many a peacock hides its tail from all eyes and calls this

– its pride.!"

99. Occasionally the truth will finally triumph, there is no doubt: some kind of error was fighting on its behalf.!®

100. The one who knows feels like God – become animal.!% tor. I listened for an echo and I heard only – praise.!"

Many people become great only after death – by means of the echo.

102. Poor artists! You wanted to reeducate this rabble and they want only – to be amazed!!®

104. "Our neighbor doesn't live in our neighborhood, but rather in theirs" this is how all peoples think.!°8

105. Substantial obligations do not inspire gratitude, but rather vengefulness.!"

106. Those who go too far eventually lie down, exhausted, to sleep even if they are in the snow: like skeptics.!!°

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107. Pangs of conscience teach us how to bite.!!!

108. There is much more intrusiveness in praise than in blame.!!?

110. The one who knows lives among humans not as if among

animals, but rather – as among animals.'!4
 ur. We forgive our opponents most completely – only their failures.'!°
 112. Out of the eyes of all who judge gazes the execution-er.!®
 113. The consequences of our actions grab us by the scruff of the neck,'!" quite indifferent to the fact that we have "bet-tered" ourselves in the meantime.
 114. "But how could you do such a thing? It was stupid!" – "Tt hasn't been easy for me either."!'8
 115. Alas! You have seen his ideal! From now on you will see in him merely the caricature of his ideal.!!°
 116. Humans would take themselves for gods if it were not for the lower half of their bodies.!""°
 117. Compassion for humankind – that would be tyranny against every individual.'?!
 118. Seeing beyond ourselves is necessary in order to – see well.!!??
 119. "All people are not equal!" – Thus speaks justice.!!??
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 120. Whoever does not see superior qualities in people sees their base qualities! from much too close a distance.
 121. Once talent grows dim in people, their moral qualities become more visible: and it's not always stars that thereby become visible.
 122. When fatigued, we are even attacked by concepts that we have long since overcome.
 123. That forgetting exists has never yet been demonstrated: but only that many things do not occur to us when we want them to.!
 124. The belief in cause and effect is anchored in the strongest of the instincts, that of revenge.!""°
 125. If people make us feel comfortable we judge their morality more positively.!!7?
 126. In striving not to know themselves even ordinary minds are still very subtle.!!?®
 127. Seeing and still not believing – is the primary virtue of those who know; visual appearance is their greatest temptation.!""?

128. What is "church"? – A fundamentally mendacious kind of state.!30

129. Carrying our gold around unminted is uncomfortable; this is what thinkers do who have no formulas.

130. Whoever intends to treat people honestly is stingy even when it comes to courtesy.'?!
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131. "The hero is cheerful" – this has not yet occurred to writers of tragedies.!??

132. The utile! is only a means; its end is always some kind of dulce!34 – now be honest, my dear Sirs Dulciarier!!?

133. Our bad qualities allow us to be rewarded whenever they have allowed themselves to be overcome by virtue.!*6

134. "Now I am just" – "now I am avenged": this sounds similar and not merely similar.!97

135. We never have: because we never are. We are continuously winning or losing.

136. Better evil deeds than puny thoughts!!98

138. We can die of thirst in the middle of the ocean and just as easily in the midst of truths that are too salty.!*°

139. For the sake of health, digestion requires a kind of slothfulness. Digestion of an experience, too.!4!

140. It is often more blessed to steal than to receive.!??

142. Not that you lied to me, but that I no longer believe you, this is what has shaken me.!44

143. All people think themselves "experts" on good and evil, and are mistaken.!*

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144. Those who praise mostly portray themselves as giving something back: in truth they want to be given a gift.!?°

145. Women stop being childlike by constantly passing themselves off as educators when they are with children.

146. We reserve our most profound love for our children or our works.!"

147. Whoever does not make us fertile will certainly leave us indifferent.!8

148. "We do good deeds for our neighbors but do not create for them": this is the thinking of all those who create.!*

149. Anger does not reveal what is in a person, but rather just

anger.!°°

150. When the age has turned against us, we have either not yet transcended it enough – or we lag behind it.

151. "Where is there still an ocean in which it would be possi-

ble to drown?" – this cry runs through our times."

152. There are many cruel people who are just too cowardly to

be cruel.

153. We must overcome even our youth in order to become children again.'?

154. "Only those who are hot can know the delights of cold-heartedness": thus spoke a free spirit.!??

155. We are most unfair, not toward that which displeases us,

but rather toward that which does not concern us at all.!°?

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156. It is certainly not the least of a theory's charms that it –

is refutable.!

157. "Good and evil are God's prejudices" – said the serpent.

158. We should question gods only in cases where gods alone can answer.

159. Many people do not find their hearts until they – lose their heads.

161. Many things become transparent to us: but this doesn't mean by a long shot that we can – get through them.

162. Learning to command is more difficult than learning to obey.

163. Not our actions, but rather our opinions and the opinions of others about our actions – make us into good or evil people.!5®

164. That the truth is simple is what error claims. error veri-

tate simplicior"?

than the crime.!®

the punishment sullies even more

168. In itself, truth is no power: if it does not join sides with

power, then it will certainly perish.!°*

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169. This is what shows who the masters are, that they neither

err nor hesitate.!®

170. What has disturbed h(umans) so much? Not things, not

opinions about things – but rather opinions about things that do not exist at all!

172. There is a hard-heartedness that would like to be understood as strength.

173. When people have just been honored highly and have eaten well, then they are at their most benevolent.

174. We notice more closely whether other people perceive our weaknesses than whether we ourselves notice the weaknesses of others.

176. Improving style – this means improving the ideas – and nothing more!!⁶⁸

177. The weakest side of a classic book is that it is predominantly written in the mother tongue of its originator!

178. We first begin to place special value on possessing a certain virtue when we have noticed its absence in our opponent.

179. All minor happiness should be used as a sick person uses

a bed: for convalescence – and otherwise not at all!⁷⁰

180. Taking pleasure in malicious petty thoughts saves human beings from many great evil acts!⁷¹

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182. If we do not raise our devil to greatness, petty devilry

makes us – petty.!'?

183. We should be a resting place for our friends, but it should

be a hard bed, an army cot.

184. When something goes wrong, assistants should be paid double for their help.!"*

185. Be modest in accepting things! Let your accepting be a mark of distinction!"

186. Anyone who keeps giving easily becomes shameless in the process.

187. When has any great person ever looked as fat and well-behaved as a good person!!"⁶

188. "I forgive you for what you did to me: but how could I ever forgive the fact that you did it to yourself!"
a lover.

– thus spoke

189. You say "I like this" and think you are praising me.
But J

don't like you –!!⁷⁷

190. "The love of oneself is characteristic of pregnancy."
192. In the presence of demigods even heroes become a laughing stock.!"

193. "How many more decades will it take before he starts to shine?" This question helps to measure a person's distance and superiority.!"°

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194. The enormous expectations that women bring to love ruin their vision for all other – distances.'?!

195. "We are only pregnant with our own child": thus speaks the selfishness of all those who create.!"8?

196. He still is perfectly innocent in his admiration: i.e., it

still has not occurred to him that he himself could be admired

one day.'??

197. Many an existence has no meaning, beyond forcing another existence to be forgotten. And in the same way there are

actions that work like opium.!"*4

I never arrived!"!®°

199. Whoever wants to justify existence must also be capable of being God's advocate!* with the devil.!"8"

200. Those incapable of love or friendship will most certainly

find their just deserts – in marriage.'?®

12 [2]

Stupidity often goes by a nicer name and calls itself necessity.!"??

r [3]

There is much foolishness and clumsy groping in what you call nature: yet your mind is definitely a part of this "nature."

12 [4]

Everything that feels, suffers, and is in prisons: but willing

comes as liberator and bringer of joy – therefore / am teach-

ing you "freedom of the will." 120

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12 [5]

Just at the point where your honesty ceases, your eye sees nothing more: oh, I know your will to blindness!!*!

12 [6]'92

If you want to make crooked all that is straight: then think

that time is gone and that transitoriness is a lie'?
Thinking this is the worst form of madness: your bones will
think they are awlirl and your stomach that it is vomiting.
12 [7]

They want to play dice with the tiniest of dice or to see
things dancing that are hard to see: the dwarves of exist-
ence,
the delightful elementary particles: but they call it sci-
ence and
it makes them sweat.

But to me they are children who want to have their game:
and if there were some laughter in their game, I would want
to
endorse their "joyful science."

2 (8)!95

Knotted taut feelings that you no longer regard as knots:
and that which often returns, in whose eternal recurrence
you

believe: this is your "reality," your best superstition.
It wasn't until I invented pleasure in the truth that I also
invented deception and illusion: for the sake of such pleas-
ure I

projected proximity and distance into things.

12 [9]!%°

All valuations have been created: every valuation destroyed.
But valuation itself, how could this be destroyed! This is
life

itself, no matter what you say – to value things!

To value is to taste.

There is no arguing about taste? Oh, you fools, all life is
tasting, and taste and disagreements about taste and tast-
ing!

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12 [10]

You fancy yourselves to be free: but you pirouette at the
end

of our wires. Values and opinions live above and within you:
we

who evaluate have made you what you are, you clockworks!

12 [11]!97

And if you want to be free, then you must not only throw
off your burdensome chains: the hour must come when you
flee from those you love the most.

You must be able to abandon your woman, your land, your
profits, your most precious beliefs: and for a time the sun
of

your life shall set for you.

12 [12]'98

And those who invent themselves will be regarded as lost
for a long time.

12 [13]!

Sleep without dreams – for me, that would be the greatest
evil. And I call all ultimate knowledge my greatest danger.

12 [14]200

Knowing: for me, this is desire and thirst and calculation
and struggle of values. Yet, as creating, all knowing must
also

be an unknowing.

To see through things, through the ephemeral net and the
ultimate veil – this would be the great weariness and the
end

of all who create.

But believe me, my friends: there is nothing that is in-
transi-

tory: it is only a symbol!

12 [15]201

To be a wish in every way and to soar like an eagle toward
faraway coasts: this is what I call happiness.

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12 [16]*°?

There are two ways to deliver yourselves from suffering:
sudden death and enduring love.

12 [17]

Once I had created superhumans, I wrapped them in the
great veil of becoming and let the sun stand over them at
noon.

12 [18]?%

Become lucid! Become well! Become necessary!

12 [19]

The drive toward procreation, toward a purpose, toward a
future, toward something superior – this is the freedom in
all

willing. Only in creating is there freedom.

12 [20]*°4

You sages, be careful that you do not founder on shame! For
fuzz is also part of a good peach.?%

12 [21]?

To our ancestors it seemed godless to grub around for trea-
sures in the bowels of the earth: now there are new insati-
able

people!

12 [22]?°"

When you felt horror while doing something harmful, then you said: this is "evil": but when you felt disgust, then "that which is bad" emerged.

12 [23]

Virtue as the final result of much expended work and effort; yet later on appearing for the first time in individuals.

"Tal-

ent" is the same – a well-trained mechanism.

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12 [24]

To judge: this is to affirm a feeling – i.e., to recognize a feeling again (which presupposes comparison and memory).

12 [25]

To clean up the inner world! There are still false entities there! For me, feeling and thinking are sufficient. "Will-ing," as

a third something, is a fantasy. In general, all drives, demands,

aversions etc. are not "unities," but rather seemingly "simple

states." Hunger: this is an unpleasant feeling and knowing how to end it. It can even have developed unknowingly out of a series of movements by the organism which are instrumental in eliminating the hunger: the stimulus of this mechanism is felt at the same time as the hunger.

12 [26]

The image prior to an action is not a concept of it, but rather

an ideal – – – –

12 [27]

How the organs develop diversely out of a single organ, e.g.,

the nervous system and brain out of the skin: in the same way,

all feeling and representing and thinking must also have orig-

inally been one thing: therefore sense impressions a /ate unique

phenomenon. This unity must be present in the inorganic: for the organic begins already with separation. The effect of inor-

ganic entities on each other should be studied (it is always an

effect at a distance," thus some "knowing" is necessary prior

to any effect: what is distant must be perceived. The sense of touch and the sense of muscle movement must have their analogues:)

12 [28]

The movements of the foot during walking and slipping – are they really the results of conscious purposeful placements

like this and like this? But even all conscious exercise is not

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what we think it is. Most of the movements during practice are experiments, and the intellect affirms the successful ones,

it does not produce them. This affirmation is very superficial,

because the intellect's image of the process is very vague.

–

The innumerable subtleties cannot be explained in this way: they would have to have been practiced, tried out and affirmed

by an infinitely more subtle intellect and observed by entirely

different sense organs than we possess. – Hence intellect does

not explain those adaptations; nor does "exercise."

12 [29]

All morality is really just a refinement of the measures that

all organic entities take in order to adapt and while still nour-

ishing themselves and gaining power. The relationship of one human being to another can be mechanistically expressed as an alteration of the arc of the motion"" of its being.

Even the most subtle alterations in consciousness must first be mechanistically possible before they can occur. In this way,

even expressions of the will are dependent on mechanistic preconditions.

12 [30]

ut let us pause at the feeling of will! at are we conscious

But let us p t the feeling of will! What

of as "will"? Here we recognize that will is merely a hypothesis.

It could be true – or maybe not.

There is no "will" beyond that of which we are conscious.

l.e., we have poetically asserted the will as an addition to certain appearances of consciousness: like "matter" as an addition to other things.

r [31]

Everything organic differs from the inorganic (in that) it collects experiences: and is never identical to itself in its pro-

cesses. – In order to understand the essence of the organic, we must not regard its smallest form as its most primitive form:

instead, every smallest cell is now heir to the entire organic past.

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12 [32]210

The quantity of compensatory systems in the body p. 195.

12 [33]

Consciousness localized on the surface of both hemispheres.

– Every "experience" that we have is a mechanical and chemical fact that cannot stand still but rather "lives": yet we know

nothing about it!

12 [34]

Wherever we have life, we presuppose "mind": but the mind that is known to us is completely incapable of doing anything.

How impoverished is every image of consciousness! It is probably

itself only the effect of a change that now draws after itself a

further change (action). Every action that we "will" is in every

way imagined by us merely as the illusion of an appearance.

–

All consciousness merely a secondary manifestation" of the intellect (?) What we are conscious of cannot provide the cause

for anything.

Just compare digestion and what we perceive of it!

12 [35]

Will is only known to us as something conscious. Yet those sudden explosions are made obscure and unclear when we supply them with such an "inner world."

12 [36]

Cherubini influenced by Gluck and Haydn, Spontini by

Gluck, Beethoven, as dramatist, by Cherubini: Gluck by Lully and Rameau. Wagner by Euryanthe!? (whereas he pretends that it's Gluck).

r [37]

Our intellect can definitely not grasp the multiplicity of clever interplay, much less produce it, e.g., the process of digestion. It is the interplay of very many intellects!

Everywhere

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that I find life, I find this interplay already happening!

And

there is even a ruling intellect is there among the many intellects.

– Yet as soon as we think of organic actions as performed with the help of many intellects: they become completely incomprehensible to us. Instead, we must think of the

intellect itself as an ultimate consequence of those organic actions.

12 [38]

The nature of heredity is completely obscure to us. Why is an action “easier” the second time around? And “who” feels this greater ease? And does this feeling have something to do

with the fact that the action is done the same way the second

time around? In that case, the feeling of different possible actions would certainly have to be imagined prior to the deed!

12 [39]

The powerful organic principle impresses me so much, especially the ease with which it incorporates inorganic material.

I don't know how this functionality is to be explained simply by increase. I would rather believe in the existence of

eternally organic entities. –

12 [40]

Listen to me for a bit, oh Zarathustra – said a pupil one day – there is something whirling around in my head; or, I would almost like to think, my head is whirling around something in such a way that it is spinning.

What then is this, our neighbor? Some facet of us, changes in us, that we have become aware of: our neighbor is an image.

But what are we ourselves? Are we ourselves not also merely

image? A facet of us, changes in us, of which we have become aware?

Our self that we know: is even this not merely an image, something outside of us, something outside, something outer?

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We are always coming into contact merely with the image and not with ourselves.

Are we not just as foreign to ourselves and just as close as a neighbor?

Truly, we have an image of people – we created it out of ourselves. And now we apply it to ourselves – to understand ourselves! Oh yes, to understand!

The state of our self-understanding is bad, so absurdly bad! Our strongest feelings: insofar as they are feelings, are something outside us, something outer, image-like: they are similes.

And what we have called inner world elsewhere: alas, it is for the most part impoverished and deceptive and hollow and poetic!

12 [41]

I'm tired of the happiness of human virtue and reason: of their

great human beings, their redeemers, liberators, poets, sages,

their just good compassionate serene conciliatory enthusiastic

people.

n [42]?

Scientific people

Asceticism of the mind – addressed to the most intellectual. "Penitents"

Herd and I. Responsibility.

the Pharisee.

Inventor of festivals.

to ennoble what is nearest

Critique of morality: in order to make us independent of praise and blame

Compensation in the beyond? You want to be paid?

Homeless.

Purification from revenge, my morality.

The most influential people lived in the greatest concealment.

1 SUMMER 1883 367

Culture – that thin little apple skin!

People not equal!?!4

the noble person a result of much work
Inventors of new states of the soul the true inventors. They
are imitated.?!°

Power wants to expend itself: not happiness.

"like a sweet smell"

the weak are the danger

the higher caste, mightier yet poorer.

To bring about the triumph of our ideal – struggle for
power in a manner that follows from the ideal.

Individuals live on within their impulses. Fame.

The need to purify the inner world and to learn!

The murder-of-God penitents and their festival.

To wean human beings from feelings of "guilt" and "pun-
ishment"!

12 [43]?!

I don't want to be mixed up and confused with others

There are those who preach my doctrine of life: but at the
same time they are preachers of equality: I don't want to be
mixed up and confused with them

People are not equal: thus speaks justice. I will tell you
such

things another time.?!"

Yet life, when it proclaimed its law to me in total secrecy,
added: "and people should not be equal either!"

Humans should keep becoming ever more unequal – for
the sake of the superhumans! – that's the way my love itself
wants it!

Whatever the father kept quiet, the son speaks of openly.

And often the son is merely the father's madness revealed.

A careworn conceit, a suppressed envy: this bursts forth in
the son as flame and madness of revenge.

This is what justice means to me – so says this madness –
that I take revenge and curse all those who are not my
equals.

368 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

And "will to equality" – this should become the name for
virtue: may my screaming about virtue rise up against every-
thing that has power!

He preaches life in order to hurt those who themselves turn
away from life: for they are mightier than he and purer of
heart.

But he himself sits in his cave turned away from life: and
spinning webs and eating flies like a spider is not what I
call

life.

His wellspring of revenge always flows too strongly: and he

always empties the cup at the same time he wants to fill it.?!3

This courtliness should also be present in speech: he who could command conceals his kingly hands beneath his robe, he persuades through his beauty, instead of commanding."" "Everything about the world displeases me: this is how he thinks – but most of all how I displease everyone." That is why he speaks of the future.?"°

Finally:

He offends my taste: this is the argument I use to fight against him.

There is no fighting about taste? Oh you fools, all of life is fighting about what is tasty and what is taste and this must be the case.??!

And I myself, my foolish friends! – what then am I if not something to fight over: a taste!???

This advocate of life sits in the belly of a whale: the whale

that he preaches against keeps him swallowed up.???

I want to bring his secrets to light: then I will laugh my laughter of the heights into his envious countenance.*°

Not with serpent locks of fear do I want to defend myself against what you teach, you preachers of equality: I protect myself from you using only beauty as my shield!??

What I love about the wind is its invisibility: and only in this way would I like to become visible, as a flame on the mast

12 SUMMER 1883 369

becomes visible: – full of astonishment, solitary voyagers see the good sign??°

He would like to be regarded as a god: but for that to happen he would have to conceal his face and shroud himself in the veil of Isis.

But I say to you: those who make an enemy of their age have yet to transcend it fully enough.

The tyrant's will cries out of him, demanding equality: his word "equality" is a tyrant's lie and seduction

That humans be redeemed from revenge – this, truly, is the rainbow of the superhumans and a bridge to the highest hope.???

12 [44]

"We have the task of teaching bears to dance: but must we ourselves be dancing bears to do it?"

So you want to tell me, you teachers: "we want to be educators: but we ourselves are not educated."

The last thing I want to do is to injure your vanity, you teachers! I have already seen too much tragedy grow out of injured vanity.

12 [45] Contest of the affects.

12 [46]

History of value judgments concerning food.

What is the value of having done (eaten) such and such – and not something else?

12 [47]? Scholars. Poets.

Great events. Prophets.

370 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

On redemption. Human prudence. stillest hour.

12 [48]

It has nothing whatsoever to do with the right of the stronger, but rather the stronger and the weaker are all equal in that

they extend their power as far as they c(an)

12 [49] Superior h(umans) like Napoleon Affects in them Mutual appraisal

Compassion and a sense of community

[13 = Z I 4. Summer 1883]

13 [1]! Zarathustra's Holy Laughter.

The hand moved forward, the clock of my life took a breath: never have I heard such stillness surround me: so much so that

it startled me.

Then life spoke to me without language: the hour has come for you to preach redemption from redeemers.?

Your minds were not yet a source of worry and heartache: your bread of life was sour, but not yet completely soured by thoughts.'

As a hunter Zarathustra set forth, hunting ugly truths: he would often return home from the forest in a dark mood.*

Oh human, this is what your knowing is: to spin and construe all things to your best advantage. To me, you all are spinners and construers, you who know!

Experience came imperiously, but my will spoke to it: then it was already on its knees, pleading.

372 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Don' you feel the thirst and the hot breath of the sun? It wants to be nursed by the ocean and drink its depths up to itself in the heights.

And now the ocean's lust rises with a thousand breasts. It

wants to be kissed and nursed by the sun's thirst: it wants
 to
 become air and height and the path of the light. And for
 this
 reason, like the sun, the ones who know love life: they want
 to
 carry the profoundest things back up to their heights.°
 Don't dancers have their ears in their toes?'
 Are you a star? Then you also must want to wander, you
 inconstant one, and to be without a home.®
 My ocean floor is still: who would have guessed that it con-
 ceals playful monsters!
 My depths are unshakeable: yet they shine with swimming
 riddles and with laughter.
 See how the woman struggles against herself and how she
 runs the comb against the defiance and will of her golden
 hair!
 They shoot off their mouths: and now we are supposed to
 think that it is out of the abundance of their hearts.
 I don't take you too seriously, you contemporaries: to me,
 you are thin and transparent: torn veils, through which
 eter-
 nity gazes. And how could I ever want to live among you if I
 couldn't look upon what is behind you and ahead of you!
 I did not find you necessary: you don't even seem superflu-
 ous to me. Truly, there is little about you that is capable
 of
 overflowing.!!°
 A star went under and disappeared: but its light is still on
 its
 way. And tell me, will you: when will it cease to be on its
 way?!
 13 SUMMER 1883 373
 Is the ocean not the greatest peacock of all? It rolls out
 its
 silver train upon soft sand, its topmost plumes of silver
 and of
 silk: when will it ever grow weary of itself? Life is in
 love with
 itself in the very same way.!?
 Midnight looked at me with drunken eyes: solitude cow-
 ered next to her and the gasping stillness of death, the
 worst of
 my girlfriends.'?
 And the thirst of the ring, eternally the same, is also my
 thirst for myself: to reach itself again, every ring twists

and
 coils itself."
 You make me laugh, you who limp along! But beware of
 those who have the will and are in a hurry: that you don't
 feel
 the weight of their heels!
 Do you want to be a stumbling block to all those who stride
 ahead? Then go to meet them and keep your head turned
 backward!
 Fear those who have withdrawn! Fear the tiger who pre-
 pares himself to spring!!®
 Up to now your spring poured forth too mightily: it always
 immediately emptied the cup in the very act of wanting to
 fill it.!7
 Stillness. Modesty at the heights.
 I wish to adorn myself with the garbage that falls from the
 table of life: and with peels and clam shells and thistles I
 want
 to be more beautifully adorned than you!'®
 Your good deeds should fall like dew upon the grass, then,
 when the night is most secretive."
 374 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS
 I think I am capable of any evil: that's why I demand, espe-
 cially of myself, that which is good!?"
 Whether you sing your own praises as poets or as dancers:
 whether you call yourselves the voice of the people and the
 servants of the public good.
 Whether you teach or paint or compose or play the game
 "Black on White"?!
 To me, you are children, all devoted to one principle and
 one
 obsession: which says "thou shalt – make a name for thy-
 self."
 Yet there are others, less common, who have a name: but
 they would like to be rid of it and erase it from all tab-
 lets.
 They hide their heads in the brush and in caves or they bap-
 tize themselves with false names: so that their terrible
 queen?"
 fails to recognize them and hurries by them in her wrath.
 Who is the terrible queen by whom they do (not) wish to be
 found???
 I call it mercy and merciful disposition, to take another's
 injustice on our shoulders and to gasp under a double bur-
 den.*
 What makes your actions good is not their reason or pur-

pose: but rather that your soul trembles and shines and over-
flows when you do them."

"the scholar">®

Now there you stand, so gaunt in your ribs that you are astonished at yourself.

And thus do you speak: did a god secretly steal away with something of mine while I slept? Truly, he did steal away with

enough to make a mere woman" out of it.

Wondrous is the poverty of my ribs!®

See him, how he swells and overflows with compassion for everything that is called human: his mind is already completely

drunk with compassion; soon he will be doing incredibly fool-

ish things.

13 SUMMER 1883 375

I come from there like a strong wind; and to those who despise

me I give advice like this: when facing the wind, be careful not to

– spit?

You wanted to sap the strength of sickness and, in my view, you have sapped the strength of the sick, you witch doctors and saviors!°9

Where I live is too high and too steep for you: I built my nest

in the tree "Future,"*! I have become my only contemporary. Whenever those who could command, persuade and hide their kingly hands beneath their robes: I call this courtesy."

My savage wisdom got pregnant atop lonely mountains: it brought forth its young, the youngest of all, on bare stones.

Now it runs foolishly through the harsh desert and seeks and seeks for soft grass – my old savage wisdom.

On the soft meadow grass of your hearts, my friends! – on your love it would like to take to bed what is most dear to it!

But what is happening to me??

What everyone knows is being forgotten by everyone; and if it weren't for the night, who would still know what light is!

Truly I say to you: Intransitoriness is only a symbol. (The thirst of the ring*

We despise everything that can be explained. A bit of stupidity let itself be surprised and stood there naked before the person explaining it.

Have you ever really seen people who did things to their own advantage?

A god who loved us would have had to do a few foolish things for our sake! What do I care about your praise of your god's "wisdom"!

376 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Your happiness is still young: be patient with it!

Bad air surrounds you: this is caused by thoughts that are floating around right now."

Not long ago I saw an image in the sea, the image of a goddess: languidly and treacherously the wave crept around her white breasts.

The sand has covered half of her and the jealousy of the wave the other half.>°

For too long I belonged to solitude: thus I have unlearned silence.

I have become nothing but mouth and the roar of a stream from high cliffs: I want to send my words cascading into the valleys.?"

I cannot abide any of you, you nightwatchmen and tomb-watchers and anyone who does nothing but blow a dismal horn.?®

I laugh at your free will and even at your unfree will: to me,

everything you call will is a delusion, there is no will.

This delusion that you call will gave birth to itself in pains

and thoughts. And because there is no will, there is also no absolute obligation.'

I probably drew this conclusion: yet now it's drawing me!"!

Humility has the thickest pelt.

Even what we have left undone weaves the fabric of the entire future: even nothingness itself is the master weaver of

all weavers.??

13 SUMMER 1883 377

Many grow weary of themselves: and only then does their happiness begin.

If you want to drive well, then hitch a little donkey in front

of the stallions of your will!

I have been wounded by my happiness: all those who suffer
ought to be my doctors!
Those who do not believe themselves are always lying.*4
When your hatred and your envy finally grow lazy and
stretch their limbs: your sense of justice awakens and rubs
its
sleepy eyes.
"those who know"

With their virtues wasted away to nothing and their fragile
souls, they have been sitting for far too long in the shadows:

therefore – they starved to death from their expectations.
"the great one"

As I turned away from myself, only then did I jump over my
own shadow: and truly, my friends, into the middle of my
sun!

Am I not modest? I live at the foot of my heights and I have
never seen my peaks: my humility cannot be convinced of
anything. Every intellect comes to – me: I love it because
it

wishes to be my intellect.

I was robbed of whatever I loved completely: now my love
overflows in torrents, down to the evening and the morning;
out of taciturn hills and thunderstorms of pain, my soul
roars

into the valleys.*°

378 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

("those who know")

You have been haggling with your own minds, you have
poisoned your blood with haggling: only by bleeding to death
can you find an antidote for your poison!

"Genius" Has a superhuman ever lived?

A horrid ringed worm has crept into the mask of a god: for
all too long I was made to play the fool by godlike skins:
ser-

pent-coils were the entrails with which they were stuffed!

And I believed I saw a god's soul at play: serpent-filth and
foul odor concealed the disguise from me. A salamander's
trick was sneaking around inside the mask of a god!?

To sanctify laughter and to stretch it like a multicolored
tent across the world – that's why I have come: to create a
new sky with stars and new wonders of the night, and I was
able to reach you by creating blacker nights for you.

I yearn and I look into the distance: on you, my eagle, I
lay

my hand, now tell me what was the most distant thing that

eagle eyes saw!

"It is showing itself" you tell me? No, my brothers, it is withdrawing, and it will withdraw more and more!*

(Contemporaries)

And anyone who knows how to remove mountains will also remove the valleys and the lowlands.*°

My drink should make you sneeze, and my sparkling wines should tickle your noses and fill you with lust.>!

The wave roared through, and the child is crying because the wave swept his toy into the abyss: but the very same wave has

poured a hundred other toys out into the soft sand for him. So

don't cry over me, my brothers, about my passing through."

13 SUMMER 1883 379

There should be no fighting about taste? Oh you fools, all of

life is fighting about what is tasty and what is taste, and this

ought to be the case"?

I smell the smell of your dust, your souls have not been aired out for so long.

I do not direct my teaching at your ears: but rather at your hands. Do as I do: only doers learn: and only as a doer will I

also be your teacher. Better to be a poor imitation of me than

to sit on your hands and worship!°4

Truly, I have as little love for hot, moist minds as I do for

chilled ones: yet if they ever come together, then something emerges that I love – a brisk blast of wind.

I thought I had landed on an island: but it was a monster that was sleeping.

I have yet to see a downfall that was not a procreation and a conception.

That a bolt of lightning would strike your feed, and your maws would have to feed on fire! –"

I have not yet walked through fire for the sake of my teachings: but my teachings walked forth out of my fire.

It was a human being who hung on the cross for two millennia: and a ghastly god had his cruel way with him and called it love.

"Everything about the world displeased me: yet most of all I was displeased that everything displeased me."

I have already bid many a farewell: but I did not slam the door – and that's why your dull ears never heard a thing.

380 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

How ridiculous I find everyone who wants to convert anyone!°

You come to me whether I want you or not: yet just as I must give to you, so you must take from me – you must take me!"

I want to be a white steer and go before the plowshare snort-

ing and bellowing: and just as my serenity lies down in the sun, so should my happiness smell like the earth.*8

Wildly my eagle beats its wings against my will: but its surge founders on this cliff."

What does "experience" still mean to them? Events sit on p

them like mosquitoes, their skin is still being pierced, but q sp

their hearts are no longer aware of it.

I don't like this pale, fat moon: in truth, I have never thought him to be the "man" in the moon. He is only a monk to me, with wet cheeks, a lecher: lecherously he creeps around

all dark corners and peers into halfclosed windows – he, the most jealous of all tomcats who wander the rooftops at night!

He is jealous of all lovers, the pale fat monk in the moon!

It is night: once again above the rooftops

The moon's plump face in promenade.

The most jealous of all tomcats, he

Looks jealously down upon all lovers

This pale fat "man in the moon."

Lecherously he creeps around all dark corners,

Leaning, braced against half-closed windows,

Like a lecherous fat monk he treads

Impudently at night on forbidden paths.

13 SUMMER 1883 381

Oh beyond this simulated light, this sweetened sickly air!

Here where the soul is never allowed to fly to its heights, but

rather is supposed to merely kneel – to the heights above.

Oh life! I look into you as into an eye.

What I can see of you is this, that you look at me: what I can

figure out about you is this, that you have figured me out!

It is winter, today I want to dance. I have enough warmth

for

this snow; I want to climb the mountain, there my warmth can wrestle with the cold winds.

Am I not the meteorological divide? Don't all winds come to me and want to know my will? I will lay my hand on everything that is to come.

You think everything is the wild play of giants and the clumsiness of giants' fists? Yet a single word arriving on the feet

of a dove guides the will of these wild ones – a word of value:

and such words come from the most profound stillness.°?

It is night: now all gushing fountains speak more loudly: and my soul, too, is a gushing fountain.

It is night, now all the songs of those who love have just awakened: and my soul, too, is the song of someone who loves.

My life is fire and burning: and the incense of my life being

sacrificed lives longer than the sacrifice. Its fragrance flies far

across the ocean: it shakes the solitary voyager to the core.

Here is autumn and harvest and plenty and afternoon and distant seas: but right now I must be a bird and fly onward above you toward noon: knowing your autumn, I prophesy for you your winter and your icy poverty.

382 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Be honest: I have figured out what is the best thing for you to believe. Now I want all of your knowledge to serve this best belief!

My speech flows too slowly. I shall spring into your carriage, you storm, and I want to whip even you with my wickedness: we want to journey over the vast seas like a cry and like a cheer.

Perfection throws a shadow ahead of itself: I call this shadow

beauty – the lightest and stillest of all things came to me as

shadow of the superhumans.

My words should root around like the snout of a boar in the soil of your souls: I want to be called a plowshare.°*

What is happening to me? My fountains have run dry and my ocean has receded: does my foundation want to crumble and engulf me in its own depths?

— Onward to immortality! Via Appia.®

And there, where your understanding has sprung a leak,
you quickly stick the poorest of all plugs: his name is
“God.”

I want to vanish in a dark thunderstorm: and in my final
moment I want to be human at the same time as I am light-
ning.

My sweetest word is now becoming like sourdough to you:
revenge is bringing you to fermentation for me, and when for
mysakeyouare completely activated and risen with your mal-
ice and your revenge, only then will I find you tasty.°7

I want to bring your secrets to light: which is why I laugh
my laughter of the heights into your countenance.

13 SUMMER 1883 383

Your countenance is dark to me, you people eager for action:
the shadow of your hands plays around your countenance, the
meaning of your eyes is hidden from me.

A thought, asleep in granite, awaits the one who will awaken
it.

In the belly of the whale I become the advocate of life.

I have seen all of you naked: and how do I now separate
those of you who are good from those of you who are evil!

My blissfulness arrives like the winds of a storm: and,
with-

out wanting to, it flings against hard walls those clumsy
peo-

ple who do not know enough to flee from it.

He is sinking, and his demons pull him down: and the
more he sinks, the more intensely shines the light of his
eyes

and the desire to be with his god.

Contemporaries

You crash up against me, for I am striking you with my oar
— and still you must carry even my boat” into immortality.”!

It is life that cuts even into life: it increases its own
wisdom

through the agony it causes itself.

A child will hold the mirror for me, the mirror upon which
the world is inscribed.”

He solves his riddles, but he does not liberate them: they
do

not fly up transformed into heavenly children.

My thoughts are colors: my colors are songs.

My knees were trembling for the very first time as I found
my way and walked onward: and anyone who saw this, told

384 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

me: you have unlearned the way, now you are unlearning even how to walk.

Now I have unlearned even how to will: accustomed to climbing, I am raised up and pulled aloft by the ether on golden threads.

Did I ever fall asleep on my fame? Every kind of fame has been like a bed of thorns to me."

All beauty lures me away beyond you humans: all beauty lures me away from all gods: so I cast my anchor upon the open sea and said: "let the island of the superhumans be here

one day!"

And when your beauty itself no longer preaches penitence, what will your words achieve!

The neck of an ox – and the eyes of an angel, these are what I want you to have!

I have become blind.

My blindness and the tapping and probing of a blind man may yet tell you of the power of the sun that I saw.

That, long ago, knowledge once learned to smile serenely and without being jealous of beauty

You stood liberated from all intellect, a sanctuary and joyful place for the intellect. Yet now I want it this way: not only should my virtue occupy your city – it should possess it;

you shall become possessed by my virtue.

I impatiently endured the winter: now even the malice of April is playing with my impatience, and often I foam over at

its halting gloom and its – derisive snowflakes.

13 SUMMER 1883 385

For the first time I once again brought together the just people, the heroes, the poets, the sages, those who know, the

prophets, the leaders: I erected my vault above the peoples: pillars on which a firmament rests – strong enough to bear a firmament. (Superhumans should speak in this way!)

Justice appeared before me: then I destroyed my idols and felt ashamed. I submitted to a penance and forced my eye to look upon where it did not like to look: and to bring love there."

the highest form of passion, the streaming passion grown still

[(Conclusion) – and all those who must someday suffer felt themselves, as sacrificial lambs, to be already anointed and to

be consecrated by tears. You call it my "happiness" –
His power streams forth out of the fullness of simplicity.

"Alas, must I then become a god?" – he spoke.

like a waterfall that pauses while cascading –

we want to saturate nature with what is human and liberate
it from godly mumbo jumbo. We want to take from nature
what we need in order to dream something above and beyond
humans. Something shall yet emerge more splendid than
storms and mountains and sea – but as son of man!"

You come from there, heavy and creaking, like wagons car-
rying stones downhill: yet your dignity is precisely that
which

reveals your downhill path – the depths are drawing you to
them!

with a well-worn sharpened tongue

386 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

I wanted to catch a fish and threw my net into the sea –
but there I drew forth the head of an ancient god: thus did
the

sea give me, the hungry one, a stone."

What are your father- and motherlands to me! I love only
my children's land, yet undiscovered, for whose sake I tell
my

sail to run over the sea and search: in this way I want,
through

my children, to make up for the fact that I am my father's
child."

Your virtue should benefit only that for which you despise
yourselves and whatever is beneficial to yourselves. Other-
wise

let contempt for whatever is beneficial occupy your virtue's
gaze."

My eagle is a ripping robber and raptor: may it be called a
danger to all little white sheep!®

Are you familiar with the terror of falling asleep? Sleepers
are shaken to the depths of their being because the floor
falls

away and the dream begins – and they often awaken again
from this terror.®!

Your sayings and puny truths flourished near the swamps,
didn't they? Yet I still hear a cold frog croaking within
them.®?

You must learn to build anew with mountains: it means
little that you can remove mountains, you who know! And
whoever removes mountains, removes lowlands as well.®3
How would you be tolerated if your cold need and power-

lessness had not been shattered by lightning and covered
with
colorful weeds! As ruins and victims of your misfortunes,
you

ought to have a right to exist!

13 SUMMER 1883 387

For you, beauty shouldn't be a hunger, but a taste; for you,
your need should be called beauty: or I don't want you.
Your desire ought not to be silenced and sink into satiety,
but rather into beauty —: the shadow of gods to come ought
to make you silent.

What is it, anyway, that is sought by all those who create?
They are all seeking new languages: they always grew tired
of

the old tongues: their minds have no desire to keep walking
on these completely worn-down, thinning soles.

Your gazing at distant oceans, your desire to set foot on
the

cliffs and their summits — it is only a language for your
long-

ing. Your gazing and your desire are only seeking humans and
that which is more than human!

Whatever contradicted them and inflicted pain, they called
God: such was the way of these heroes. And they didn't know
any other way of loving their God than to nail a human being
to the cross.®*

And therefore let us be enemies, my friends! Just as the
arches in the vault above you break into pieces and play off
against one another:

as light and shadow, in their enmity, are secure and beautiful
like gods above you: in this way, your thoughts, and
those

of your friends, ought to be secure and beautiful like gods
in

their enmity.

You don't want to hear that someone is strolling around
above your heads. And so you put wood and earth and refuse
between him and your heads — that's how you muffle the
speech of his steps.®

388 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

You put all human error and weakness between yourselves
and me: you call this a dead floor in your houses.

But in spite of this, I stroll around with my thoughts above
your heads: and even if I wanted to stroll around on my own
errors and dead floors, I would still be above you and your
heads! *°

And now the ice and innocence of my peaks are also still
aglow.*"

You who desecrate, do you still not understand what desecration does? The toppled ornamented column lay in the slime of your contempt: – and it is precisely out of your contempt that the column's life, and living beauties, suddenly awakened again.

It arose with more godly features and seductively suffering, you desecrators of the ornamented column! – and still it thanked you for its deification!®®

Dionysus on a tiger: the skull of a goat: a panther. Ariadne dreaming: "abandoned by the hero, I dream about the super-hero." Keep quiet about Dionysus!

Every action requires interpretation: it beckons to all solvers

of riddles. I gave new words and methods to the interpreters:

so that they can make better forecasts of human weather.°?

I am a seer: but my seeing is followed inexorably by my conscience: thus I am also the interpreter of my visions.

Black ponds from which the sweet gloom of a toad sings

forth: this is what you are to me, you priests. Who among you

could stand to show himself naked!

You do well to lay out your corpse in black, and I hear the evil-spiced dullness of death chambers resounding from your speeches.

13 SUMMER 1883 389

How I hate the lying convulsions of your humility! In your kneeling I see the habits of slaves, you lickspittles of your God!

Yesterday, when the moon rose, I thought that it wanted to give birth to a sun: it lay there on the horizon so wide and heavy with young.

But it was a liar with its pregnancy: and I no longer believe

either in the man in the moon or, truly, even in the woman in

the moon. – I am giving you this parable, you enthusiasts and moon-children.

Barren and yellowed it rose, and it got smaller and smaller, looking paler and more deceptive as it climbed. Truly, its bad

conscience shone forth from within, the old lecher.

It lusts for this earth and yet this lust makes it ashamed,

it would

much rather imbue its glances with holiness and abnegation.
And even if you, too, lie broad and heavy with young on the
horizon: truly, for me you will not give birth to a sun!

(Romantics)

Lusting for the earth: yet your bad conscience bites you in
your lust: that's why you choose melancholy."

To me, you are arid grass and steppe: but I want to make
wildfires of you and heralds with tongues of fire?!

Life, I look within you as into an eye!

Gold flashes from his eyes: a golden bark floats there upon
dark waters. Please look, for me: this gold dances leaps and
crouches! ??

You are adept and have clever fingers. But you have no idea
how to make a fist.

Not until your clever fingers have crept back into a fist
will

I want to believe in your power."

The worm-like thing I struggle against I first created for
myself in the form of a dragon: it was still so young and
tiny

and in this way I am fighting the fight with your future.

390 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

But if you wanted to fight and win, I would first have to
turn the dragons of today into earthworms for you!?*

You are tools and watches to me and nothing more: thus I
want to wind you up with my ridicule, and you will purr with
contentment as I do it!"

And I still prefer to sleep on ox hides than on the bed of
your complacency and love."

You see only my sparks, but you do not see the anvil that I
am, you do not guess how cruel my hammer is.""

I do not want to turn you into stones and silence with ser-
pent locks of fear: I protect myself from you, using only
"beauty" as my shield.

Do you hear the sound and the laughter of this shield? It is
the holy laughter of beauty: through it you are meant to be
struck dumb for my sake?'

I know how to ride you: and anyone who knows horses well
also knows just what it means to be in the saddle."

I still am like a cock in a strange barnyard, pecked at by
hens.!°°

I want to be known as a fire and as a danger to all dried-
out

souls: glowing ashes ought to fly up from me.

Again I am solitary and exiled. I have been exiled into my

solitude by my friends and by those who love me. For this is how I want to speak to my enemies.

I want to speak to those who hate me: perhaps I can persuade them more effectively than I can persuade my friends. And thus today is the day I lust for my enemies, the way I once lusted for all truth. Truth is what I once called every-

thing that caused me pain and the greatest pain possible.

13 SUMMER 1883 391

I want to pour out all the evils of my soul against my friends: perhaps I would in this way seduce my enemies into that which guides me.

By your love? Alas, now it comes back to me, the ghastly knowledge – who was it who drove me into the wilderness and made me into someone wild?

All for naught! For naught! Yes, you yourselves drove out the wild one: it is the will of friends that made me into a cave bear.

Alas, who was it who made me solitary and wild and into a cave bear of the wilderness?

Alas, who exiled me among loveless stones and storms Did not cry out No!!" three thunderclaps and three lightning bolts striking at midnight?

And when I look into my picture book, a dog and a child should be looking over my shoulder.

Grace is part of the magnanimousness of those inclined to greatness.

Like buffalo, I sense you near the sand, even nearer to the underbrush, yet nearest to the swamp.!"?

With many small doses it is possible to cure a brave man and make him into a coward.!"%

You should pass by these enemies quietly and with a sleeping sword. Be careful not to attack them! for those who attack

them sully themselves.

I, the earth-born one, am experiencing the ailments of the sun as my own eclipsing and as a great flood of my own soul.

392 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

I believed myself to be the richest one of all, and I still believe

it: but no one takes from me. Thus do I suffer from the madness

of the giver.!"

I do not touch their soul: and soon I will not even reach their skin anymore. The last smallest gap is the most diffi-

cult

to bridge. Did I not cause you the most pain when I did what was most precious to me?!

My love and my burning hunger for them grows with my exile, and even the insanity of my love makes me more distant

from them and less understandable.

But I am in exile: they have turned their eyes from me. And I do not even touch the skin of their soul anymore.

Alas, and now my hunger for them grows, ever since I have been known as the exiled one: and this insanity of love makes

me even more strange and terrible.!"

My love of speaking. Against silent people.

With chests puffed out, and like those who are holding their breath: thus are you, you sublime ones! silent.

Beauty is what I call the revelation of what is good for the senses: of my good! for my – senses! And what intellect used to be now becomes only quasi-intellect for me!!%®

Now my hope has become too well fed: at this point, it has ceased to hope (I am no longer one of the ones who hope).

I flew too far into the future, I was overcome with horror.

When I finally looked around, behold, time was my only contemporary there. And so, I was longing for you, my contemporaries.

And even those who want to prepare poison for themselves must put on gloves of glass.!"

13 SUMMER 1883 393

I gave them their nothingness to feed on; then they choked on their nothingness.!!°

I held up a mirror to their ugliness: then they could not bear the sight of themselves: they came to grief on the evil eye

of their own eyes.!!!

I did penance for all of this injustice, my admiration was even more unjust than my contempt.!!?

No matter how blind you already are: greater still is the will

to blindness that I found in your eyes.

Alas, I know the blue evening distance of your deception:

truly, I prefer the lies of those who know they are lying to your

lies. 3

And you would be even less able to put up with my modesty than with my pride, if it ever wanted to speak.

My narrow path runs between two dangers: a pinnacle

called "arrogance" is my danger, an abyss called "compassion"

is my danger.

"How I will want to draw a breath and stretch my limbs when I will have borne my burden to the highest pinnacle!" – the hero often thought this on his way up. But when he was at the top, and had thrown down his burden, then he did not do this – then he overcame even his weariness: and here a godlike shiver ran through his body.

The electricity of my cloud was all too great and too long-lasting: between lightning and thunder, it finally hurled

showers of hail and ice into the depths: it violently puffed out

its chest and violently blew its storm clear across the mountain-

tains – thus came its relief.

394 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Truly, my happiness and my freedom arrive like a storm: But you think the evil one himself is racing over your heads!

Having laid his arm over his head: in this way the hero rests, in this way he also overcomes his resting.

Today I want to free my slaves and to be their servant and their sport: the drink of freedom should go to their heads and their hearts.

You now lie in the foreground for me, you contemporaries: if you don't want to become ruins for me, how could I bear to

have you in my picture! And, for me, the best thing about you

is your weeds!

The figs fall from the tree: they are sweet and good. And as they fall, their red skin rips. I am a north wind to ripe figs!"⁴

Are you afraid of the fervor of your tones, you harpers and poets? All your harping-jingle-jangle is ghost-breath and keen-

ing to me: you finger your scrawny strings with scrawny hands, but when would you ever have swept away a heart? – if it hadn't been swept away by pity at your poverty!!⁵

See that you do not smear or wash away the woman's likeness on my behalf, you fashionable people!

How high up do I live? Never yet – whenever I climbed – did I count the flights of stairs up to where I live: – yet

I know

this much about my pinnacle: the roof over my head begins in that place where all stairways end.!!®

—those who must be hauled up by their hair into heaven!!!

You throw dust around yourselves like sacks of grain, you scholars, and without meaning to! Still, who would have guessed

13 SUMMER 1883 395

that your dust comes from grain and from the golden bliss of summer fields?

To the hero, the beautiful is the most difficult of all things:

for the hero, more than anyone else, the beautiful is unwinna-

ble and unreachable.

A little more, a little less: just this is a lot here, just that is

the most here.

We must speak to slack and sleeping senses with thunder-claps and heavenly fireworks: but the beacons of beauty speak

softly, they tiptoe only into the souls of those who are most

wide awake.

You claim to be made of finer cloth, you visionaries? But I say to you, you are only better at dressing and disguises,!!

® you

know how to hide poor cloth beneath a cloak!!!”

Now and then even wretched people become honest: it happens rarely enough! — then it is advisable to listen to their

voices and to climb into their swamp.

And once I, too, sat down among the reeds and in this way I heard the frogs of wretchedness make their confessions.!?”

And so proud of a handful of justice, you commit sacrilege against all things and drown the world with the waters of your

injustice.

They stand on the street for hours, watching people passing by: and others of their ilk sit idly in their parlors, watching

thoughts that pass them by. I laugh at these contemplative people.

396 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Tell them no, and spit at the same time: then they will quickly throw themselves to the ground and lick up your

spit-

tle. But among modest people every priest grows insolent:
his

humiliation takes revenge on all who have been humiliated.
Nothing thirsts more for revenge than the humility of a
priest.

With languid muscles, and beautiful, as befits a benevolent
person: and truly: what is beauty, if not benevolence mani-
fest-

ing itself?

When excessive power becomes benevolent and its benevo-
lence descends into the visible: such descents are what I
call

beauty.

The sun never rose above the turbid sea of your soul: and
you know even less of the sun's bliss as it sets.

My compassion became a murderer: and when I loved humans
the most, I nailed humans to the cross.

I am poorer now than any human being: the cup was emp-
tied. My riches are gone: now truly, I myself have become
human again.

I redeemed them from their redeemers. – Yet how could
superhumans bear to understand humans! That's why humans
must be persuaded to create them and to perish for their
sake:

so that the superhumans can Jive?

The danger for superhumans is compassion. Let us avoid
giving them compassion! – But my bliss now lies in my
downfall. (From the final speech)

They want to use their virtues to claw out the eyes of their
enemies. They rise up because they want to put others
down.!"!

13 SUMMER 1883 397

I want to see only the gentleness in violent people as their
selfovercoming, and I laugh at the weaklings who think
themselves "good" because their claws are dull.

When have great people ever been their own followers and
devotees? They definitely stepped away from siding with
themselves when they stepped onto the side of greatness!

I truly want to be a power, but not some uncouth driver and
beater:!!? instead, wherever a wind sweeps, I wish to sweep
along within it: and even if I am otherwise invisible, I
still

want to become visible like a flame on the masts of solitary
voyagers and explorers.!!?

You should grow like a column into the heights, ever more

delicate and slender, but harder within yourself and with
bated
breath: thus does the column strive ever higher.
"This is how I would like to die! And to die once more! And
1"
to live in order to die this way!" And yet, the moment she
died, she was smiling: for she loved Zarathustra.
A storm rumbled from out of the sky, as yet unseen.
Then thunder rolled: and afterward came a stillness – this
stillness wound itself around us as if with terrible coils,
and
held us fast: the world stood still.!24
Then the woman proclaims the coming of the eagle and the
serpent. The sign. Everyone fleeing. The plague.
She pulled Zarathustra's arm to her breast.
And, once again, the abyss drew a breath: it groaned and
roared, its fire shooting upward.

398 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Here is the cave of the tarantula: do you want to see it?
Then buzz like a fly. Its web hangs here: touch it so that
it
trembles.
I want to teach you to dance ecstatic dances: for, to me,
you
are the most melancholy of people. I want to cure your
melan-
choly through madness.
He placed a naked image of a god there: in this way, the
southernmost of all people still longs for a (second) south.
To me, you are a tarantula: and the triangle, the
tarantula's
identifying mark, sits black upon your back. Bite these
shal-
low people for me, with your poisonous bite, so that for my
sake their souls receive depth and melancholy and black
scabs
for the first time.
To the teachers of pessimism.
B p]!?
Act 1. Zarathustra among animals. The cave.
The child with the mirror. (It is time!)
The different petitions, intensifying. In the end, the
children seduce him with song.
Act 2. The city, outbreak of the plague. Zarathustra's
appearance, healing of the woman. Springtime.
Act 3. Noon and eternity.

Act 4. The voyagers.

Scene at the volcano, Zarathustra dying among children.

Funeral rites.

Omens.

for 3.) Zarathustra saw and heard nothing, he was lost in rapture.

Then, step by step back into the most terrible knowledge.

The outrage of the disciples, departure of the most beloved

13 SUMMER 1883 399

ones, Zarathustra tries to stop them. The serpent feels for him

with its tongue. He recants, excess of compassion, the eagle flees. Now the scene with the woman, in whom the plague resurfaces. He kills out of compassion. He embraces the corpse.

Then the ship and the appearance at the volcano. "Zarathustra is going to hell? Or does he now want to redeem the under-

world?" – Thus the rumor spreads, he is also the evil one. Last scene at the volcano. Total bliss. Forgetting. Vision of

the woman (or of the child with the mirror) The disciples peer

into the deep grave. (Or Zarathustra among children at the temple ruins.)

The greatest of all funeral rites as the conclusion. Golden casket thrown into the volcano.

13 [3]}6

Put a saint on a ship: the ocean itself will flee before the saint and roar in fear. This is how the most peaceful of all humans brings on the storm: and anyone who was wind and wave will run away from me on quick feet.

Yes, I am a forest and a night of cypresses: but anyone who does not shy away from my darkness will also discover hanging beds of roses under my cypresses.

I want to give you clear sight and a dread of the real: in this

way you should learn to float along after me into distant futures.

And do not be angry with me if I whip this puny god a little: he fell asleep on me here at the fountain, the dawdler; maybe he tried too hard to catch butterflies?

"I may have broken my wedding vows: but first my wedding vows broke me" said the woman.!7

400 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

"Now I have become a lake with white roses: the winds of the heights play with me and laugh like children. What haven't I forgotten! Who hasn't forgotten me! And often I still forget even my forgetfulness." Zarathustra among children. The distant cliff throws my word back at me and in this way mocks my forgetting – yes, I have forgotten it already, what-
ever I cried into the distance. Alas, what haven't I forgotten!

"He has already been in the underworld?" –

"Certainly he has been there: clearly he has been among us! Humans, humans alone are the underworld!"

"Zarathustra is dead? You don't know what you are saying! Don't we see him striding along! Truly, he still wishes to redeem

the underworld and to bring it to light." – "He is going to hell,

the devil will take him!" "Take my word for it, the devil will

not take him – how would he manage that!, but he will take the devil for his own!" – The voyagers. The End.!8

"I have thrown my intellect into a pit of snow."

And if the stars don't want to fall from the sky for you, then

throw your stars into the sky: let that be the extent of your
evil.!2°

"I speak: for I have seen. Now I must be nothing but mouth: for recently I have been nothing but eye and innocence of the
mirror" Thus speaks the artist.

"You know it, don't you, Pana my child, my little star, my golden ear – you know it, don't you, that you are dear to me as well?"

Love for me persuaded you, I see that: but I still do not understand the will of your love, Pana! –

13 SUMMER 1883 401

But as he saw his serpent's tongue touch him, then his face transformed itself ever so slowly: the gateway of knowledge reluctantly sprang open for him: like a lightning bolt the knowledge flew into the depths of his eyes and again like a lightning bolt: another moment, and he would have known – – When the woman saw this transformation, she screamed as if in the throes of distress. "Die, Zarathustra" – With his left hand he forced back the eagle, which was beating against him with the fury of its wings: it screamed,

like someone advising him to flee; it would have loved to carry him away from there. At his right hand on the rock-slab table

Those who want to be merely spectators of life should be careful not to sit there, where the sun beats down on the stairs:

unless they want to become blind.

"And what should I do with your knife, Pana? Should I cut the golden grapes from the vine? Behold, what abundance surrounds me!"

And even at night he will not perish for your sake, but rather blood red, like a midnight sun, he will remain on the horizon.

People who wanted to conceal themselves, and had no choice but to be shamed by the clear sky, created for themselves these sweet-smelling caves.!!??

And only when grass and red poppies flourish on the walls, and the sky peeps through shattered ceilings, only then will I

want to turn my heart toward these places of your god.'?!

How would I have endured it if I didn't love superhumans more than you!!*?

402 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

For what purpose did I give you the hundred-faceted mirror in the first place? And the eternal gazes?!

I overcame even love for you with love for the superhumans.

And as I endure you, you must endure yourselves, out of love for the superhumans.!!34

To me, you are the stone in which the most sublime of all statues sleeps: there is no other such stone.

And as my hammer swings at you, you should swing at yourselves for my sake! The call of the hammer should awaken the sleeping statue!!*

And should I want to mount my wildest steed, my spear will get me up there the best: it is the most ready servant of my feet.

The best mask we wear is our own face.!!36

Streets of tombs: leading wherever it is most beautiful, most

clear and most bright. Not to dismal places.

And when I hold a mirror to my own beauty, my soul shudders with divine desires: and veneration is still part of my vanity.

And kings should still lead the ass of my wisdom.

And as I lay sleeping, a sheep was cropping the ivy crown on my head!

In striving upward against my burden I rejuvenated myself: and just when I became more hardened within myself, I also learned what grace is.!?7

13 SUMMER 1883 403

Inventive in small stratagems and lusting for those whose intelligence walks on lame feet: thus do they stand and wait before their wares, these hucksters!!38

Pity all those who love who do not also have a pinnacle that is even above love and compassion.!?%

On ashes, I stride up the mountain of ashes, at dusk: my shadow grows long and longer.

A boat floats in the depths of the violet-shrouded sea: its sailor stares up at me, his hand shading his eyes.

Now Zarathustra is journeying to hell – this is what the ferryman says shuddering and taps his cross.

Don't touch the cross on my account, you were wrong! The devil is not yet taking me, ferryman! maybe I am taking the devil

as my own!!*®

At the very least his hound of hell should answer to me I want an answer from the abyss of his jaws.

He should groan and roar his fire and ashes up at me: that's how I like monsters to answer me.!!*

Few understand the art of staying noble even while being reverent: and I much prefer to see shameless people and their

innocence than the contorted eyes of your devotion and obeisance!

Now only the smallest gap still stands between me and you: but alas! Who has ever built a bridge across the smallest gaps?!42

Your knees pray for something and your hands are hosannas: but your heart knows nothing of it.!!*3

I once threw myself with giving hands into the heights: but as I was falling, I was caught upon three lances – in this way,

as a sacrifice, I made my way from the heights to the earth.
404 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

I placed my foot on the lower jaw of the wolf: that's how I ripped his jaws open.

laughing, the kings of the North die –

a ribbon woven from the beard-stubble of a virgin and from the sound of feline footsteps –

Who will hold the basin up to my countenance, so that the

viper's poison drips into it?
 I do not want wisdom to become a hospital and a poor-
 house for mediocre poets.
 As if there were only one stile into the future: like sheep,
 they crowd around their stile:
 "the one who knows made into the one who creates"!

And what do you care if my torrent throws itself into false
 ways and impassable chasms: for how should a torrent not
 find
 its way to the ocean?
 Indeed, I have found a lake within myself: this lake is a
 her-
 mit and is self-satisfied: my torrent of love threw itself
 into this
 lake: and now the torrent of my love is sweeping the lake
 along
 with it into the ocean!

"We have no opinion at all unless we are given one: and we
 are being given one.
 We have no strength at all unless we are thought to be
 strong:
 and everyone thinks us strong" –pitiful people, contemporar-
 ies.

I tolerate you and I carry you, up to now I have always
 found
 you to be lightweights. And even when I gasp under my own
 burden, loaded down with myself, what difference does it
 make
 that you beetles and sea slugs take your seats on my bundle!
 13 SUMMER 1883 405
 against "morality"

And when, instead of the pure "I will this," I heard the
 call
 "thou shalt" coming from clumsy maws, that's when my dan-
 ger began: I hated my pure "I will this" coming from clumsy
 maws –
 I have annihilated your good and evil, I have torn these
 nooses
 to pieces: only in this way did I learn to love my goodness.
 The art of all tarantulas is black and blackening: yet I
 call
 tarantulas the necromancers of the mind, who are called the
 teachers of "the worst possible world."!44
 If there were gods, how could I stand not being a god? But
 there are no gods.!®
 His soul rejoices in secret over the fact that revenge is

still

being taken in every form of justice: and my soul rejoices
over

the fact that in every form of revenge a spark jumps from
the

anvil of justice.!?®

You are in love with great words the same way you are in
love with colorful brats: and your foot knows how to hold
festivals on carpets of lies, you milksops! (idealists)

You compassionate ones, when you throw yourselves down
from the heights to the people below, what price did you put
on broken limbs?!4"

But it was silent: terribly and doubly silent. Alas, you do
not

know it, the double stillness that ties up hearts until they
shatter.!48

Alpa! I screamed. Fear and longing screamed forth from
me: I wanted to hear a voice again

A voice coming from a human being, as it is carried away by
a wind or a bird.

406 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Strong will? This is a lot, yet not enough: I need an endur-
ing strong will, an eternal resoluteness born in hardness of
heart.!?

How this laughter broke my windows! How it ripped apart
my guts and slit open my heart!!°°

This is the most unforgivable thing about you: you have the
power and you don't want to rule.

You see, don't you, the one they all need the most. This is
the one who can command.

None of them want to bear the burden of those who don't
take orders, but they accomplish the most difficult things
if

you order them to do so.'?!'

A will that demands monstrous things is rare: you will have
an easier time finding a will that does them.

There is no longer a strong wind and will driving you: you
are standing too stiffly for my taste, and your backs are too

straight.

Alas that, already rounded and full of air like a sail, you
went over the sea, and you were trembling at the storminess
and breath of a will!

Now all air is heated, the breath of the earth is fire. Now
you all go naked, you good and evil people! In this way,
those

who know will have their festival.

Yes, this is the world without clothes. What caused the earth to move? Was it not the stillest words of a saint? Every deep knowledge flows cold, the deepest wellsprings are ice cold: and that's why it is refreshing to all hot hands and

heated doers.

13 SUMMER 1883 407

I love the turbulence of a bad reputation: just as the ship loves to hear the resistance of the wave through which its keel

breaks. My own path seems easier when resistance foams around me.!*

But just as I was awakened by you and came to myself, so I tell you to awaken and to be awakened by yourselves.

And why did you not want, you too – my brothers – “to come to me?”!>4

Approach the wellspring with humble hands: this is how it will fill your hands most easily.

Redeemers? You were the binders and tamers:!*> you should be given that.!!°°

Today I am sick of people, today animals will be dear to me. And today I have buckets of love” to waste on them.

Oh, if only I could be a sower and a gardener among animals! I would certainly find an earthly realm there in which more eminent things would grow than the creatures I have grown so sick of.

Speak your word no matter what! Founder on it! What is it with you and your modesty! My modesty is unspeakable.'>®

You wanted to show that your grandfather was right and that truth has always been on the side of grandfathers.

For a grandfather belongs more to the people than any grandchild does.

You are looking back, even if you are going forward: and people can't help running into you a lot.!?

408 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

You really like to think you are building the city of the future: but, in addition to that, you are erecting the tombs and

honors of past worlds.

13 [4]!°°

“Kill him, if you have to power to do so” – Zarathustra called out in a terrifying way once again; and his gaze pierced

the thoughts of the king.

I recognize Zarathustra, said the king with a smile: who

else

but Zarathustra would know how to abase himself in such a prideful fashion? But that which you rescinded was a death sentence.

– and (he) read slowly from the death sentence, with his voice half-lowered as if he were all by himself: he who deserves

to die – Zarathustra, seducer of the people.

– deep in thought, he moved back a few steps, into the window bay; he didn't say a word and did not even look at Zarathustra. Finally, he turned toward the window.

You said it, King: the idol that goes before the people, the idol that turns them into idol-makers: the idol should become

king to the people!

The time for kings has passed: the people are no longer worthy of having kings.

Destroy, you should destroy, oh King, the people who don't follow idols: these are humankind's worst enemies!

Trample the worm, that those who create!°! –

And if the kings themselves are of that ilk, then, oh King, destroy the kings, as you are able!

My judges and advocates of justice have reached an agreement to destroy a harmful human being; they are asking me whether I want justice to run its course or to let mercy prevail

over justice.

What is more difficult for a king to choose, mercy or justice?

Justice, answered the king; for he was a man of mild disposition.

Then choose justice, and leave mercy to violent people as their means of overpowering themselves!

13 SUMMER 1883 409

Yet, as he looked out toward the window, he saw something, and then his face turned a different color.

Zarathustra, he said in the polite tone of a king, forgive me

for not answering you immediately. You gave me a piece of advice: and, truthfully, I would love to listen to it! – But it

comes too late! – With these words, he tore up the parchment and threw the pieces on the ground. Silently they took leave of one another.

Yet what the king had seen from his window, was the people: the people were waiting for Zarathustra.

13 [5]

All of you are not fighting for justice, you righteous people,
but rather so that your image(s) of humans triumph.
And so that all your images of humans founder upon my
image of superhumans: behold, this is Zarathustra's will to
justice.

B [6]!%2

To the Teachers of Equality.

You don't want to hear that someone is strolling around
above your heads. And so you put wood and earth and refuse
between him and your heads.

That's how you muffle the speech of my steps.

You put all human error and weakness between yourselves
and me: you call this a dead floor in your houses.

But in spite of this I stroll around with my thoughts above
your heads: and even if I wanted to stroll around on my own
errors and dead floors, I would still be above you and your
heads!

For people are not equal – thus speaks justice. And what I
want, you are not permitted to want.!%

They want to use their virtues to claw out the eyes of their
enemies: they rise up because they want to put others down.!%

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"Now I am in the right" "now I am avenged" – this sounds
similar and often doesn't just sound similar!!®

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His bad qualities allow him to be rewarded whenever they
have allowed themselves to be overcome by virtue!°®

In every one of his laments there is revenge.

I want to bring all of your secrets to light: that's why I
laugh

my laughter of the heights into your countenances.

My sweetest word should become like sourdough to you:

for my sake, revenge should bring you to fermentation.

And not until you have overflowed the pot and floated away
in your malice, will I want to taste you and find you
tasty.!%

13 [7]! The Idol-Makers.

When your hatred and your envy finally grow lazy and
stretch their limbs: only then does your sense of justice
awaken

and rub its sleepy eyes.!®

My drink should make you sneeze: my sparkling wine
should tickle your noses and fill you with lust!"°

To sanctify laughter and to stretch it like a multicolored

tent across the world –

and whenever I had to create blacker nights for you, then I also brought you new stars and new wonders of the night.!7! My words should root around like the snout of a boar in the soil of your souls: I want to be called a plowshare.!7?

No matter how blind you already are: greater still is the will

to blindness that I found in your eyes."

Alas, I know the blue distances of your deception: and I prefer the lies of those who know they are lying to your lies.!74

Just there at the point where your honesty ceases, your eye sees nothing more."

The best mask we wear is our own face.!7°

What is the problem with them making sculptures of the gods naked? – In this way, the southernmost of all people still longs for new souths.!77

13 SUMMER 1883 411

13 (8)!78 The Penitents of the Mind.

Are you a star? Then you also must want to wander and to be without a home, you inconstant one!!7?

Now there he stands, so gaunt in his ribs that he is astonished at himself.!8°

And thus does he speak: "Did a god secretly steal away with something of mine while I slept?

Truly, he did steal away with enough to make a mere woman out of it. Wondrous is the poverty of my ribs."

Justice appeared before me: then I destroyed my idols and felt ashamed.

I submitted to penance: I forced my eye to look upon where it did not like to look – and to bring love there.!8!

And those wishing to prepare poison for themselves must put on gloves of glass.!8?

My admiration was even more unjust than my contempt.

The figs fall from the trees: they are sweet and good. And as

they fall, their red skin rips. I am a north wind to ripe figs.!84

And full of pride at a handful of justice, you committed sacrilege against all things and drowned the world with the waters of your injustice.!8°

And whatever intellect once meant to me is only quasi-intellect to me.'8°

We can die of thirst longing for water in the middle of the ocean, and just as easily in the midst of truths that are all too

salty.!87

Those who go too far end up lying down to sleep even in the snow – out of fatigue.!#®

Pangs of conscience teach us how to bite.

Eventually the truth will really triumph, some kind of error was fighting on its behalf.!?°

Humans are the animals with red cheeks: humans are the animals that have too often had to feel ashamed of themselves.!”!

There are libertines of the mind: there are also penitents of

the mind.!”

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13 [9]! The Shortest Summer.

Up to now my spring poured forth too mightily: it always immediately emptied the cup in the very act of wanting to fill

ir.194

This is all April still and May and June: and the way I am, near snow, near eagles, near death I will have a summer, short,

hot, gloomy, and overflowing with bliss.!?5

Alas at the halting gloom of my spring! Alas at the wickedness of my snowflakes in June!

It is night: now all gushing fountains speak more loudly. And my soul, too, is a gushing fountain.

It is night: and now all the songs of those who love have just awakened. And my soul, too, is the song of someone who loves."

If I were dark and of the night, how I would want to thirst for light and to drink the light!

I would bless you, you little twinkling stars and lightning bugs, and swallow you whole.

But now I am entirely engirded by the light and I squander it around me: alas, I do not know the pleasure of taking.

And often I have said to myself "Is it still more blessed to steal than to receive?" – thus I spoke from a great distance.

13 [o]!

Wherever I saw life, I found will to power: and there too, in

the will of someone who serves, I found will to power.

We subjugate ourselves to something greater in order to

gain mastery over something lesser: this pleasure convinces us

to subjugate ourselves.

Whatever is not, cannot will! Yet whatever has existence – how could this still – “will to exist!”

You believe that you know things and all things: that’s why you posit value and tablets of goods. This is the superstition of

all who make valuations

To me, you are only a river on which a boat floats along: yet

in the boat sit value judgments in disguise, the solemn ones.

13 SUMMER 1883 413

Honest science begins in this way: it asks: what is? and not:

what is it worth?

Whatever is needed for human beings to remain in existence: these are our limits.!?®

Even your ideal is by no means your limit: your power extends further than the longing of your eye.

The sun went down long ago, the meadow is damp, coolness is coming from the woods: something unknown surrounds me and looks down pensively at me. What, you still live! Why do you still live?

Whatever moves us from within, this astonishes us, as something incomprehensible: now we invent sounds and words for it

– and now we think, too, that it might have become comprehensible. This superstition is in everything that makes sounds:

the insanity of the ear.

Will to truth? Oh, my wisest brothers, this is a will to making

the world conceivable.”

Even the world should now be visible in its smallest dimensions: then you think you can grasp it: this is the folly of the eye.

Let us speak of it: even if it is bad; to be silent about it is terrible!

I saw other oceans, their blue seemed unbelievable to me, it seemed to me like makeup on rough skin: the blood flowed down gray and ghastly. But here is the ocean’s blood – blue. Nothing is more costly than a false illusion about good and

evil!

"A good human being is impossible: life itself contains nothing but ill-will, delusion and injustice. And this would be

the ultimate will to goodness, to deny all life!"

With your good and evil you have estranged yourselves from life, made your will weary; and your assigning value was

itself the sign of a will in decline, longing for death.

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13 [r]200 The Way through Many Souls.

I come from there like a strong wind: and this advice I give to my enemies: when facing the wind, be careful – not to spit!%0!

I made my way through a hundred souls, I took my leave often, I know the heartbreaking final hours.??

Yet this is how my destiny wants it. Or to be honest with you: this kind of destiny is what – my will wants!

All who want to invent themselves must be regarded as lost for a long time.7%

When were great people ever their own followers and devotees? they stepped away from siding with themselves when they stepped to the side – of greatness!%?

I want to vanish in a dark thunderstorm: and in my final moment

I want to be human at the same time as I am lightning.?"

I probably drew this conclusion: now it's drawing me!

The wave roared through, and the child is crying because the wave swept his toy into the abyss. But the very same wave

has poured a hundred other toys out into the soft sand for him. So don't cry over me, about my passing through!?"

And endless too, like the thirst of the ring, is my thirst for

myself: every ring coils and twists in order to reach itself again.?"

Experience came imperiously: but my will spoke: then it was already on its knees pleading.?"®

I have already bid many a farewell, but I did not slam the door: that's why dull ears never heard a thing."

3 [r]210 On those who speak freely.

That a bolt of lightning would strike your feed and your maws would have to feed on fire for a time!?!?

You wanted to catch a fish and threw your net into the sea. But there you drew forth the head of an ancient god.?!?

Thus did the sea give you hungry ones a stone: you left it

alone there.

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There the goddess lies forever: languidly and treacherously
the wave creeps around her white breasts.

The sand has covered half of her and the reverence of the
wave the other half."

Your sayings and petty truths grew well near the swamps,
didn't they? Yet I still hear a frog croaking out of
there!?!*

You are adept and have clever fingers, but you have no idea
how to make a fist.

Not until your clever fingers have crept back into a fist,
will

I want to believe in your power.?"

You are but tools and watches to me and no more! Thus I
shall wind you up with my ridicule and you will purr with
contentment for me as I do it!?!°

"It has always been this way! And it will always be this
way!"

And I would still prefer to sleep on ox hides than on the
beds of your complacency."!"

We know a little too much about everyone. ?!?

13 [13]?

Against Mediators.

I am well disposed to all pure things: how could I be well
disposed to you conciliators!?!°

All you mediators and equivocators, you half-and-halfers,
you high-strung conciliators – you are not pure!

How much like gods the vaults and arches here break into
pieces, as they wrestle: how they play off against each other

with light and shadow, those who play like gods:

Therefore let us be enemies in a secure and beautiful way,
my friends! Like gods – we want to play off against each
other.??!

You obscurers, you ask what will become of you if you tell
the truth –

but the truth should shatter the world, so that the world
may be built!???

We should train our hearts by forcing them to do things.

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Those who give their hearts free rein, soon lose sight of
their
heads.

It is noble to be ashamed of our best things because we
alone have them.

"I am annoyed: for you are wrong" – this is how a lover thinks.

I love life: I despise human beings. But it is for the sake of

life that I wish to annihilate them.

13 [14]? Associates and Associations.

I don't take you too seriously, you contemporaries: to me, you are thin and transparent!??*

Torn veils through which the future gazes: half-open doors, at which gravediggers wait!

And how would I ever want to live among you if I couldn't look upon what is ahead of you!

I did not find you necessary, you don't even seem superfluous to me: there is little about you – capable of overflowing.

You crash up against me, for I am striking you with my oar – and still you must carry my boat into immortality."

And many a woman has said to me: "I may have broken my wedding vows but first my wedding vows broke me."??°

And if I am to love you completely, then you have to be my child or a work of mine.??7

Whoever does not make us fertile will certainly leave us indifferent.?*®

We can do good deeds for our neighbors, but we cannot create for them.?"?

Your will is still too proud and shy! should you wish to drive

well, then hitch a little donkey in front of the stallions of your will!?30

They will build beehives like Towers of Babel?!

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13 [15]??? New Ways of Life.

What are your father- and motherlands to me? I love only my children's land, yet undiscovered, for whose sake I tell my

sail to run over the sea and search.

Through my children I want to make up for the fact that I am my father's child: and thus to redeem the past.

To be a wish in every way and a bird on the way to faraway coasts: this is happiness for me.??

Whether the truth benefits or harms you or me – what do I care! Let us create people for whom the truth is beneficial!

B (16)?34

On Actors.

Is the ocean not the greatest peacock of all? Even in front
 of
 the ugliest of all buffalo it rolls out its train, it will
 never grow
 weary of its topmost plume of silver and silk.??
 The buffalo looks on obstinately, in his soul near the sand,
 even nearer to the thicket, yet nearest of all to the swamp:
 what are beauty and ocean and peacock finery to him!?*°
 To you actors, I give this parable. Truly, your spirit is
 itself
 the greatest peacock of all and an ocean of vanity.
 Your spirit wants spectators: even if they should be buf-
 falo!
 You play: and you want spectators at your games – I call
 all of you actors.?*"

Whether you sing your own praises as poets or as dancers:
 whether you call yourselves the voice of the people and the
 servants of the public good:
 Whether you teach or paint or compose or play the game
 "Black on White," such a pathetic game:
 One principle and obsession speaks from all of your doings:
 I want to make a name for myself! – that's how it speaks.?7°
 Faith brings bliss – that's what you all say – especially
 faith in ourselves.?

I listened for an echo, but I heard only praise.?4°
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I wanted to build them and build them up – butthe rabble
 just wants to be astonished!
 Talking a lot about ourselves is also a means of concealing
 ourselves."4!
 13 [17]?

On Tarantulas.

_ Here is the cave of the tarantula: do you want to see it?
 Then buzz like a fly.
 Its web is hanging here: touch it so that it trembles.
 To me you are a tarantula: and your triangle and identify-
 ing mark sits black upon your back.
 Bite these shallow people for me with your most poisonous
 bite, so that their soul receives depth and melancholy and
 black scabs for the first time.
 I flew too far into the future, I was overcome with horror.
 And when I looked around, behold, time was my only con-
 temporary there. In that place I was longing for you, my
 contemporaries!
 The art of all tarantulas is black and blackening: this is
 what

I call the necromancers of the mind, who are the teachers of the "worst possible world."

Do you want to make crooked all that is straight? Then think that time is gone and that transitoriness is a lie.? Thinking this is the worst form of madness, and tarantula venom. Your bones will think they are awl and your stomach that it is vomiting.

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B [18]?

On Poets.

The intransitory – this is only a symbol; and poets lie too much.

They also know too little and are bad learners: that's why they have to lie so beautifully.

And clouds are their favorite things: they put their most colorful little brats up there and call them gods.

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And when they lie in the grass under the trees, and little impulses caress them: then they always claim that nature itself

is in love with them.

And let it come to tell them secrets and to flatter them:

yes

the poets swell up and strut around on account of such intimacy beyond that given to all mortals.

He sinks and his demons pull him down: but the more he sinks, the more his eyes fill with glowing light and with lust

for his gods.

I know how to ride you and how to saddle you anew. And anyone who knows horses also knows well what it means to be in the saddle.*°

You harpers and poets, what have you known up to now about the fervor of tones!

All your harping-jingle-jangle is ghost-breath and keening to me: with scrawny hands you rip into scrawny strings!??

And if the stars don't want to fall from the sky for you, then

throw your own stars at the sky and let that be the extent of

your evil!°48

We praise only what appeals to our taste; i.e., when we praise, we always praise our own taste: which really violates all

standards of good taste!°4°

They thought they were being bold, whenever they said: "all

knowledge is nothing."

"Boredom and lusts" – from this they wrote the story of the one who knows.

eager for things that old wives?" tell

"Praise be to the know-nothings and spiritually impoverished!"

you are making your listeners feel longing and pangs of conscience for whatever is no longer in them: yet I tell you:

you must make them thirsty for whatever "has yet to be"! Those who create, love themselves in the process: therefore they also must hate themselves most profoundly – they run riot in this hatred.

"Praise be to the spiritually impoverished, especially when they are young and female!"?*

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Who among you poets would not have diluted his wines with deception? Many a poisonous concoction was mixed in your cellars.??

13 [19]°°° Among Cripples.

And still I prefer to live among cripples than to live among these supposedly whole people."*4

The achievement of perfection casts its shadow ahead: I call this shadow beauty.

The lightest and stillest of all things came to me as shadow of the superhumans.?°°

God, too, has his hell – said the devil: it is his love for humans.?° B [20]?>"

On the shame of the gift-giver.

On the clamor for equality, against desecrators

On intoxication (spasms of penitence) priests.

On speaking freely ("historical education")

On the honesty of the pitiful.

On geniuses.

On marriage by the hour. Adulteress

On new associations and monasteries.

On punishment as the enemy of enemies.

So you want to be paid?

Annihilation of morality. The dream. Cosmic dependence.°®

Anthropomorphizing nature. Redemption from redeemers."""

First you have to learn to hunger for knowledge.

The murder-of-God penitents and their festival.

Purification from revenge. On the indiscretion of priests.

Hunt for ugly truths.

Greatest funeral rite – onward to immortality?

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The renunciation of the metaphysical as what virtue demands
 – as self sacrifice.
 The blessed isles. "To the south."
 On modesty.
 Value of the pessimist.
 Madness of someone who gives.
 Scholars.
 Contemporaries.
 Laughter of the heights. Happiness of the sower.
 Stillness of the saint.
 The seductions (child with mirror)
 Beauty.
 Compassion.
 Idealists.
 to seduce the pious
 (Die, Zarathustra!)
 the funeral pyre (big city) 13 [21]?
 The typical sufferings of the reformer and even his consolations. – The seven solitudes.
 He lives as if above the ages: his pinnacle gives him contact
 with the solitary and unappreciated people of all eras.
 His beauty is his last defense.
 He lays his hand upon the next millennium.
 His love grows as does the impossibility of doing good with it.
 13 [22]? Three additional parts:
 2. The Laughter of the Heights.
 (Happiness of the Sower.)
 3. Zarathustra searches for those he has lost.
 (or the 7 Solitudes)
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 13 [23]
 The characteristics of superhumans gradually becoming more visible.
 The laughter of the heights – the caves of S.A.
 Concerning the last scene the appearance at Stromboli."⁴
 The woman's speech. "How well you heal, savior!"
 Always ten years in between. Solitude.
 At the beginning of the last book a child appears with a mirror
 in Zarathustra's cave, as the first sign of his triumph.[°]
 13 [24]2[°]
 Praise of reason and its coolness.
 In his role as one who creates, to praise the fact that our

wisdom is revealed as folly, our wealth as poverty.
Thirst! If my thirst were quenched, what would be the point
of creating! Justification of suffering.

High summer in the mountains.
sweet smell, melancholy, regarding a sudden death, evening
in the woods where elves walk.

the great human being "has fallen"

Hymn to the organic: Zarathustra feels himself related in
his will to everything living, deepest understanding of
nature

and of what is moral.

Zarathustra says "I am the pleasure"

of the mistral wind of electricity of the heights

of the change of seasons (ring)

of the clear sky of the dawn of the torrent of organic life

the sun's thirst for (the) ocean

plowshare (as persuasion)

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Way of life: to nurture ourselves such that we create our-
selves in our own image.

Sensual hateful people like to eat plants.

13 [25]?

First: laughter of the heights. Dream. Postlude.

Laughing at redeemers and compassionate people mediators
reconcilers ethical world order ("paid") Idealists "idol-
makers"

Revolutionaries – Deniers. Conversation with the hound of
fire. Poets Geniuses. On peacocks. Scholars Educated people

Those who speak freely Equality-socialists

Pessimists tarantulas "necromancers of the mind."

Metaphysicians Those who know – "torrent"

("I am the coffin full of malicious deeds and masks of
life")

Society

against "long life on earth" – "high summer" – "clear sky"

Priests and churches Sublime people (for beauty) Hucksters

Frugal people (nature mystics) Vanity of cleanly people

Curious people

Romantics (moon). To heal "sorrowful people" by means of
frenzied dances, to throw off shame and later to find that
the bridges leading to dissimulation are broken.

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13 [26]

There have never yet been any superhumans!

13 [7]? Actors. Tarantulas. Hound of fire. The dream. Those
who speak freely. Penitents of the mind "Paid" Summer in the

mountains. new society. Way of life. Through many souls wandering among fragments cool reason Organic – moral. Mediators.

To one of the illustrious dead.

13 [28]? The Funeral Rite. On the Contemplative Ones. On Actors. Redemption from the Redeemers. The Dream. On Famous Sages. Heroes and Beauty. On Tarantulas. High Summer. Conversation with the Hound of Fire.

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13 [29]?° Hound of Fire. On Tarantulas. Penitents of the Mind. Among Cripples. On Those Who Speak Freely. On Preachers of Equality. New Ways of Life. Associates and Associations. 13 [30]?*1 The Child with the Mirror. The Night Song. The Dance Song. The Prophet. The Funeral Rite. On Gods. On Famous

Sages. On Those Who Are Sublime. On Contemporaries. On Scholars. On Contemplatives. On Good and Evil. The stillest Hour. On Priests. On Poets. On the Compassionate. On the Rabble. On Virtuous People. On Great Events On Human Prudence 13 [31]? On Tarantulas. Conversation with the King. Among Cripples.

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13 [32]? On Poets. On Contemplatives. The Funeral Rite. On Human Prudence. On the Land of Culture. On Scholars. On Those Who Are Sublime. The Dance Song. The Prophet. On Good and Evil. Among Cripples. Conversation with the King. The stillest Hour.

13 [33]

Upon the Blessed Isles On the Rabble.

On Tarantulas.

On Famous Sages.

the night song.

the dance song

the grave song.

On Self-Overcoming. Sublime People.

(On the) Land of Culture. immaculate perception. Scholars. Poets.

great events.

Prophet

Redemption.

H(uman) Prudence. St(illest) Hour.

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13 [34]?

On Contemplatives.

On Scholars.

On Those Who Are Sublime. On the Land of Culture.

On Poets.

On Human Prudence.

The Prophet.

On Redemption.

The Stillest Hour.

13 [35]7°

On Immaculate Perception. On Scholars.

On Poets.

The Prophet.

On Great Events.

On Human Prudence.

On Redemption.

13 [36]?"" The Child with the Mirror. On Those Who Are Sublime. On Contemplatives. On Priests. On Famous Sages. The Dance Song. The Funeral Rite. The Stillest Hour.

[14 = M III 2b. Summer 1883]

14 [1]! Philosophy of the Future. On the Innocence of Becoming. Body and Mind. Moral and Organic. A Millennium of Experiments. Art. The Free and the Unfree. Education and Nourishment. Men and Women. Freely-Chosen Death. The New Order of Rank.

The Greeks as Connoisseurs of Humanity.

Music and Philosophy. etc. etc. nothing but lectures and speeches.

14 [2]

On evil: i.e., inferior beings want to gain an advantage over

superior beings by exploiting a single trait of those who are

superior (e.g., their trust).

Evil is: exploiting the virtue of other beings who belong to a

superior species (parasitism).

A first-rate organizing power e.g., Napoleon, must be related

to the species that is to be organized (i.e., it matters little whether

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he has "noble" feelings: it suffices that he appreciates completely

and fully the strongest and most characteristic features of the

many.)

Exploiting the backward characteristics of someone else who is generally more noble— parasites. (women)

Humankind has a relationship of calculated utility with nature as a whole: but what is it that upsets us when individuals exploit others for their own benefit? – The assumption is that they are not worthy enough. But assuming that they are considered worthy enough (e.g., as princes), then they are to be tolerated and they provide a kind of happiness (“devotion to God”)
We guard ourselves against exploitation by beings lower than ourselves.
Thus I defend myself against the contemporary state, education, etc.
Evil is first of all a judgment about other beings: if we call something about ourselves evil, then it is a metaphor – we do not want to see a drive that we have classified as /ower playing the ruler, – such a drive does not in any way have to be negated, but it should maintain its subordinate position and nothing more!

14 [3]

Superior human beings should be heads of state: all other forms are attempts to provide a substitute for the self-evident authority of superior human beings. (The ancient law does not become sacred until it Jacks the power to make laws.)
All lower drives must be present and have fresh force if the highest ones want to exist and to exist in abundance: but control over the whole must be in firm hands! otherwise the danger is too great! – In regard to this danger, there was the desire

to kill off the lower qualities completely (but with self-deception:

Christians retained their affects, but employed them differently, just as Cynics kept running their abusive mouths)

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or the desire to make them “gently” prudent and thereby to have them no longer want to sanction the highest impetus,’ e.g., Epicureans.

14 [4]

Humankind still has so much more ahead of it— how
could we possibly derive the ideal from the past any longer!
Perhaps, by still deriving it from the present, which is
perhaps
a nadir.

14 [5]

The abuse of power by the Roman emperors disrupted moral
concepts in Europe: the morality of the powerless achieved vic-

tory: — consequence, a monstrous counterfeiting.

The true source of lofty feelings is in the soul of the
power-

ful. Self-evident joy in themselves and their deeds is the
origin

of all value judgments — faith in themselves.

[15 = N VI 5. Summer–Autumn 1883]

15 [1]!

Now clear skies of eternity seize my senses, the dew drop
Summoning the opponent. Value of human beings 1) abundance,
multiplicity 2) total power 3) communicative force

15 [2]

I hate people who don't know how to forgive.

15 [3]

If only one moment of the world were to return, — said
the lightning — then all moments would have to return
absolute necessity seen as shield covered with imagery!
(chap(ter)) astronomical image of the world
(chap(ter)) beyond the midpoint of life — life has been
sacrificed.

15 [4]

Zarathustra's conclusion is that humans must form them-
selves back into animals in order not to feel the thought.
Or into superhumans (breeding through choice of place
lineage diet etc.) Break with the past (unhistorical mode of
thought necessary for this

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to form a kind of "people"

not to be rid of error! as condition of life!?

NB. To stage tragedies in life and to enjoy them!

15 [5]

Dissolution of "free will" and responsibility into a predic-
tion and a degree of probability based on our knowledge of
ourselves.

My horror at "guilty" people is a horror at having deceived
myself in my predictions.

15 [6]

Zarathustra does not want to dose any of the past of human-kind, he wants to throw everything into the mold. Transformation of force.

15 [7]

Zarathustra III. A) sudden clarity about himself. Why care about giving gifts! Why care about making people happy! About friends! About love! It is pride that makes him speak the truth! His great contempt is coming.

1 (chap(ter)) he looks for his animals and can no longer find them. Despair of the solitary one. Can no longer go back!

2 (chap(ter)) Temptation of suicide

3 (chap(ter)) Regret. Forgetting the past. Commanding as an experiment and roll of the dice.

In the /ast speech even the death song must be fulfilled – e.g., the good hour

to join with the ones who create, the ones who harvest, the ones who celebrate: this happens as part of the exclamation: what have you done?

4 (chap(ter)) thunderstorm rainbow lioness – doves

At the end: do you will this?

“Not Z – but I would like to create the one who says: Yes.”

15 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1883 433

At the end, the animals arrive from the sky (pride and cleverness return)

(chap(ter)) IV plan for the festival, derived from the entire

system of world observations

Conclude every chapter in (Zarathustra) 3: “Zarathustra, do you will this once again?”

15 [8]? Moldenhauer Scott Monastery-Abbot Haller Old Span.’

Pindar Coleridge. Zinzendorf v(on) d(er) Goltz® Meister

E(c)khart and mystics Swedenborg

15[9]

Zarathustra 3 as volcanic eruption.

Zarathustra 4 “I am the one to whom oaths are sworn.”

Human beings are something fluid and malleable – we can make them into whatever we want.

To stand fast for 30 years.

Zarathustra 4. you should be like the sun – and what does the sun zot do!

15 [10]

The Lawgiver Type.

his development and his sorrows.

What is the point of giving laws?

the general type of the l(awgiver), who is the herald for many lawgivers.

Chief doctrine: at every step, to achieve perfection and a feel-

ing of well-being – don't jump!

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First, giving laws. After the prospect of superhumans, the doc-

trine of recurrence in horrific fashion: now bearable!

15 [11]

cause and effect are lacking in mental processes (mirror)

15 [12]

To enjoy every penetrating sunbeam and every delight as metaphor and omen – not in itself}

because we should create a being who will strike everyone blind.

15 [13] (chap(ter)) Arrange festivals Festival of cosmic designations Festival of the earth Festival of friendship gr(eat) noon. Graves, worm!

Oh, how I would want to curse him if he resembled – any other person!

But not even the relief of cursing!

Mockery of "trust in life"!

15 [14]

Zarathustra 4 Doctrine of shared joy.

Zarathustra 3. Beginning. My premature happiness created clouds and shadows for me

15 [15]

I want apostles but not quiet corners and communities.

15 [16]

Roar wind, roar! Take every comfort from me!

15 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1883 435

15 [17]

tortured by my happiness – otherwise it is immediately gone again!

I throw the fishing rod over my head, far out into the sea of

the future

Zarathustra 3. against the complacency of sages – against "joy-

ful science"

The downfall of the blessed isles awakens him! Happiness in his failure. Greatest suffering with the insight that whatever

was gained in life up to now has been lost: massive failure!

—

Finally, he decides to teach his doctrine hundreds of times!
15 [18]

You have set your mind against what is human? But for
humanity's sake, no!

Now I am clairvoyant, my diamond sword cuts every dark-
ness to pieces. For too long I was obsessed with clairvoy-
ance.'

An infinite process can be conceived in no other way at all
than as periodical

3. Why didn't you drive them apart? They had found each
other, well, it was time to look for others.

Good days must walk on good feet.°

15 [19]

Laws as backbone – working on them and developing them
further

Zarathustra gives the model of how to behave with regard
to the law, in that he suspends the law of laws, morality,
in

favor? of superior laws

achievability greater than before (individual access to
inter-
pretation)

NB. it must be achievable (and) a superior ideal and its
law must grow out of this achievement!

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15 [20]

As soon as you believe that alongside absolute causality
there

might also exist a god or a purpose – then the thought of
necessity is unbearable.

15 [21]

Zarathustra 3. The evil demon who comes from goodness is a
consequence of every teleology. Zarathustra 3. – Hym(n) mod-
esty – Hym(n) solitude Failure and its consolation.
in conclusion.

Zarathustra himself has become a sage who delights in his
own foolishness and a pau per who delights in his own
wealth.

the fool and the happy pauper – possessing the tremen-
dous bliss of those who ho pe and long and prophesy

Zarathustra 3. I have been concealing the worst objection to
life: it is, in the long run, boring

the new saint sanctifying nature

the new artist.

The redemption of evil people Zarathustra 3.

To rule? ghastly! I do not want to impose my type. My hap-

piness is multiplicity!

Problem!!°

To invoke agon!!! those very people who would like to hide themselves away, quiet, pious people, – bid for dominance!

Solitude only a means of education!

against all those who merely enjoy things!

Even solitude falls under this perspective!

Self-overcoming and all virtue make no sense at all other than as a means of enhancing the ruling force.

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15 [22]

Zarathustra 3 on the seduction of imperious people, noble people – deepest contempt for the comfortable for those obsessed with tranquility

15 [23]

My friend, you are like a cork, made for the light and for the surfaces of all seas – we called you fortunate

15 [24]

Zarathustra 3 Yes, if you could do that! Z(arathustra) –

Zarathustra 3. he praises the vastness of the soul – he has been licking all good and evil things.

15 [25]

I love myself with a bad and fickle love – and occasionally I think I probably deserve a better love than the one I am giving myself.

15 [26]

Your false love of the past is a theft from the future (divine ancestry"? of values)

15 [27]

Zarathustra 3. even if you want only your ideal, you must force all the world to accept it.

you debase your action when it is done only for the sake of a purpose

We must force the masses to be reasonable and even whip them into doing things to their own advantage

Zarathustra – I unlearned how to be empathetic with myself.

forgetting the self. Emerson p. 237.1%

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Zarathustra 3

those who give gifts, those who create, those who teach – these are preludes to those who rule.

Which unhappiness is too much for me? We only ever expe-

rience our own happiness.

Zarathustra 3. against authority. When voices stopped speaking, you made a law out of this.

Zarathustra 4. A force that is conceivable to you must be finite and determinate – but intransitory.

15 [28]

We should not bless our enemies: but the time will come when we have no more friends, and then we will still bless the

fact that we didn't curse them!

15 [29]

Every thought, like flowing lava, builds a fortress around itself and crushes itself with "laws."

15 [30]

It's not that my ocean is receding, it's that my land is grow-

ing, my new ardor is lifting it upward.

Blessed are those who outgrow their own success.

With this thought, I tow the future behind me.

Forming a new star from the debris of old ones.

15 [31]

Not to do good for people – to perfect existence itself, to see myself as perfected

3. The greatest pain: Zarathustra's useless squandering as eternally repeated.

Solution: try once again!

When I suffered more than any human being, I did not bear their sins and weaknesses, but rather all their perfections.

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15 [32]

(chap(ter)) On the sages' happiness at their foolishness (not

knowing the ultimate results –)

(chap(ter)) On the wealth of poor people (eternal longing)

15 [33]

Egoism and individualism

Egoism falsely labeled according to design, calculation, and altruism labeled as uncalculating, but cold calculation on the

part of the statesman as well!

15 [34]

he who blasts me with invisible lightning bolts.

You wanted to give a gift with your overflowing: but as you must be someone who creates, you must give even yourself away.

And truly, you yourself are the best part of your overflow-

ing

There lies a man who knows how (to) take what is rightfully his – of those who could give him what is rightfully his, who

would be there!

How could I love humans for humans' sake!

15 [35]

3. Zarathustra I bring you my sins as a sacrifice and throw the sacrifice on top of you (shaken)

to the thought – God – hammer

If you stand high enough, then you must bring them up, bring them up to you!"

Executing the gods.

(chap(ter)) Praise of primordially determined nature

15 [36]"°

Where there is danger, I am there and I am rooted in the earth.!6

Training under the fire of cannons shooting at a distant target.

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"An arms salesman impatient at possibly being detained by someone."

As field commanders, we should let neither the victors nor the vanquished rest

to grow calm when the great danger comes.

"I want to do it or die"!®

"Without wrath, there is no conquest" Aristotle.'?

beautiful and horrible to look at Zarathustra 4 conclusion.

Behind the armies, a reasonable regime of terror.

"errors arising out of a good-natured disposition are most egregious in dangerous matters" Clausewitz°

courage that comes from a sense of honor and self-esteem not to

be confused with organic courage: a compulsion whereby we sacrifice much of our ability.

"Cunning better than force.

"This earth is too small for great ambition!"??

"love of glory the true measure" of a prince" Friedrich."

»21

15 [37]

"I am giving away all that I have – now I have nothing left but the great hope" Zarathustra 4

Zarathustra 4. Do I really need them? But they need me!

15 [38]"

customs that keep the blood boiling and harden us to the sight of suffering, necessary for education.

drive to annihilate, unrelentingly hard-hearted

15 [39]°°

To respect the crowd's faith and spoon-feed them with it
– remaining skeptical ourselves, we must control even faith.
Caution and mistrust in matters of personal safety does not
rule out disdain for death.

"when life is at stake, we should not trust even our own
mothers"?

This is my secret coat of armor.

15 SUMMER-AUTUMN 1883 441

"In war, deception is everything"?® the foxes' hide.

"opinion is half of reality" Nap(oleon).??

Wherever a great good is involved, we should preserve our
reputation

Nobility cunning boldness bravery determination foresight
perseverance deep contemplation

Intentionality of delusion, to be the favorite of the gods
in

order to influence the masses

To come to the aid of the gods!

"Human beings are too enlightened, nothing great can be
accomplished anymore" Nap(oleon)*°

Predetermination of all events. "All great things hang by a
hair" Nap(oleon)*!

their temperament jolts them out of the passivity of fatal-
ism

"to horse, sabre in hand, to become destiny themselves." 3?

15 [40]

With "in order to," we have created a compulsion and anni-
hilated freedom. Concerning redemption from purposes.

15 [41]

Perfect people do as little deliberate good as they do de-
liber-
ate harm.

15 [42]

ideal of the physician

Having sacrificed our lives. Like a fighter in the ring who
gives his all and is not at all certain of victory

Epicurean happiness as that of a convalescent

15 [43]

I want to have my events, even if I do violence to them.

They want to be loved, these weaklings!

Not that you overturned idols, but rather that you over-
turned the idolater within yourself –

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And if I must be guilty, then I still want all my virtues to

kneel before my guilt

There is a happiness lying in the lap of things such that
all

my happiness casts shadows around its lights.

15 [44]

Conclusion 3. Feeling of dissipation and resignation

"you are too early"

Zarathustra 4. general outbreak of a mor(al) sense, volcanic
– Zarathustra is needed

15 [45]

Zarathustra is stewing in his own juices.??

His resolution perceived to be the greatest decision about
the

fate of humankind.

"to bring the universe into harmony into reconciliation and
into knowledge" in this, the human soul is the greatest work
of
art.

Greatest awareness of the importance!

the universe does not seek its own redemption, but it finds
it.

15 [46]

Zarathustra 3. Forward, lame-footed one, smuggler – or Pl
jump etc.

that's how it screamed at me.

Life itself created this most burdensome thought for life,
it

wants to leap over its highest barrier and away!"

The fool.

The king. fall into despair when they are great people

The woman.

15 [47]"

like a child, the people can only have faith: what they should
have faith in –

the solid realism of this observation also in Rée in regard
to

morality.

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15 [48]

Zarathustra 4 the new order of rank of human beings

bad people (strong people

etc. (weak people

the many-faceted people, with the will to suffer and to get
lost and to experiment, straying off course, returning – not
fearing the most monstrous path

to free up the sky.

Light-hearted depths, where even a star becomes a speck.
 3 Problem: My will to do good (even for myself!) forces me into complete silence.
 But my will for superhumans tells me to speak and even to sacrifice friends.
 Zarathustra 4. What we take to be bad, exploiting the weak, deceiving noble people into doing things they must be ashamed of. Great curse on friends!
 I was lying in the sunshine: then came the blackest cloud. It floated like a funnel above me, leaning on the sun. It was the sun itself, – – –
 This thought leaps over me and away!
 Zarathustra 3. After several chapters of fear and indecision, summoning up the great thought.
 Conclusion: I have the hammer! – bliss!
 And if vermin disgust you so much that you quickly move up a step because of them – then they should have the right to exist!
 15 [49]
 cold egoism – to exploit the weak: why does it run counter to feeling?
 the same person is perceived differently by our different drives
 444 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS
 15 [50]
 To know," a delusion.
 Even laws of nature merely long-held habits.
 Assuming that someone has a strong will, then a skeptical philosophy is best in order to spur this will most effectively to action.
 Express trains everywhere! the rich too warmly clothed morality of the weak as mimicry?" – wanting "to absorb."
 15 [51]
 not to want the means only for the sake of the end!
 Conscience is the feeling whereby we become aware of the order of rank among our drives.
 15 [52]
 Unconscious memory
 Comfort (as the longest-lasting happiness that is possible for ancient philosophers)
 Skepticism suffices against all metaphysics
 15 [53]

to locate all bliss in skepticism (the doubt concerning pessimism)

15 [54]

(chap(ter)) dis-satisfied people as life principle (One virtue!)

15 [55]

Limitations of the moral point of view – every individual plays a part in the whole cosmic entity – whether we know it or not – whether we want it or not!

15 [56]

(chap(ter)) molding and remolding process of pious people, of priests

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15 [57]

(chap(ter)) the herald's call to individuals (and their ideals)

15 [58]

law for lawgivers

We must transform ourselves from those who pray into those who give blessings

15 [59] imperious people the – – –

15 [60]8 *Hartmann M(iscellaneous) W(ritings)?* Ranke Popes'? Wellhausen"! vlon) der) Goltz Dreher'? Moldenhauer Zinzen-dorf Bentham-Benecke®?

Buddhism by Kern Leipzig Otto Schulze*

[16 = Z II 1a. Autumn 1883]

16 [1]

Nature must be imagined as analogous to human beings, as erring, experimenting, good and evil – as fighting and overcoming itself.

16 [2]

There are three solitudes, that of someone who creates, that of someone who waits, that of shame. – I know the word and sign of the superhumans; but I don't say it, I am concealing it

from myself. – To live in shame, in the face of a great truth.

16 [3]

In Act II the different groups come and bring their gift.

"What did you do?" – They say it. – "Then it is done in the spirit of Zarathustra."

The rabble, cold and without much inner need, will be the first to smile at the doctrine of recurrence. The most basic life

drive is the first to give its approval. At the very end a great

truth wins over the most superior humans: this is the suffering of truthful people.

Act I. Solitude as a result of being ashamed of himself: An unspoken thought for which he feels too weak (not hard-hearted

enough) The temptations to mislead him about this. The messengers of the chosen people invite him to the festival of life.

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Act II. He attends the festival incognito. He reveals himself

when he finds himself venerated too much.

Act III. In happiness, he proclaims the superhumans and their doctrine. Everyone deserts him. He dies as the vision leaves him on account of the pain he feels at the suffering he

has created.

Funeral rite. "We killed him" – Noon and eternity.

16 [4]?

The gentlest person must become the most hard-hearted: and perish in the process. This the psychological problem. Experience came imperiously: but my will spoke to it – then it was already on its knees, pleading.'

Don't dancers have their ears in their toes?4

Zarathustra's virtue still lives for us! A star went under in

barren space: but its light is still on its way and is transformed

– and when will it cease to be on its way"

Do you want to be a stumbling block to those who stride ahead? Then limp along in front of whoever is in a hurry.°

Even what we have left undone weaves the fabric of the entire future: even nothingness itself is a weaver and master

weaver.'

Many grow weary of themselves: and only then does the happiness begin that was reserved for them.®

My drink should still make you sneeze, and my sparkling wines should tickle your nose and fill you with lust.?

"It is showing itself": says your complacency? No, it is with-

drawing and it will withdraw more and more.!!°

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16 [5]"

The profound sterility of the 19th century. I have not met a single person really capable of introducing a new ideal. For a long time, the character of German music gave me false hopes.

A stronger type in which our powers are synthetically fused

—
my faith. Apparently everything is *décadence*. This downfall must be guided so that it makes a new form of existence possible—

ble for the strongest people.

16 [6]

Don't be impatient! Superhumans are our next step! For this, for this limitation, moderation and manliness are required.

16 [7]?

Do as I do: only those who do, learn — only as a doer will I also be your teacher."

That a bolt of lightning would strike your feed and your maws would learn to feed on fire!

The pride of my eagle whips my will with its wings: but the surge of pride also founders on this cliff.

Am I not the meteorological divide? Don't all winds come to me and proclaim their will to me?!®

I want to vanish in a dark thunderstorm: and in my final moment I want to be both human and lightning."

You crash up against me — but to no effect! I am striking you

with my oar: you still must carry my boat into immortality!!

®

Did I ever fall asleep on my fame? Every kind of fame has been like a bed of thorns to me."

Perhaps as Zarathustra III: This is the book of the seven solitudes.

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"And the ice and innocence of my peaks are also still aglow."*®

To me you are arid grass and steppe: but I want to make wildfires of you and heralds with tongues of fire."!

Gold flashes in his dark eyes: a golden bark floats there on black waters.??

You are clever and have clever fingers: not until your fingers

have crept back into your fist, will I even want to believe in

your power.??

I know how to put my checkered saddle blanket on you: and

anyone who knows horses also knows just what it means to be
 in
 the saddle.*4
 I still am like a cock in a strange barnyard, pecked at even
 by hens."
 There is more injustice in admiration than in contempt.?°
 How high up do I live? Never yet when I climbed did I
 count the flights of stairs to where I live: where all
 stairways
 end, that's where the roof over my head begins?"
 You will have to be hauled up by your hair into your
 heaven!?!®
 You claim to be made of finer cloth, you visionaries? That
 you don't merely know how to dress and disguise yourselves
 better! You know how to hide your substance beneath a cloak
 y better!
 If I remain otherwise invisible, then I still wish to be
 visible
 at the masts of solitary voyagers and explorers – as a flame
 and sign of hope.°°
 450 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS
 Didn't the world stand still? How this silence wound itself
 around me with terrible coils and held me fast?!
 A woman said: "I may have broken my wedding vows. But
 first my wedding vows broke me!"??
 To seduce those who love us so that they do something that
 is shameful in their eyes and ours – this is the cruelest
 thing
 that cruel people do.
 And if the stars don't want to fall from the sky for you,
 then
 throw your star into the sky – let that be the extent of
 your
 evil!
 And those who throw themselves down from the heights at
 the people below: what price did they put on broken limbs?*4
 You are also looking back, when going forward: and people
 have to run into you a lot."
 I listened for an echo, but heard only praise.*°
 Talking a lot about ourselves is also a means of concealing
 ourselves.*"
 Whoever does not make us fertile will certainly leave us
 indifferent.*®
 We do good deeds for our neighbors, but we do not create
 for them.??
 Eventually the truth will really triumph: some kind of error

was fighting on its behalf.*°

Just at the point where your honesty ceases, your eye sees nothing more“!

16 AUTUMN 1883 451

His bad qualities allow him to be rewarded whenever they have allowed themselves to be overcome by virtue.*?

He is so convincing that he convinces the arguments themselves to run after him.”

16 [8]*

That Zarathustra reaches the highest level of distress and that not until then does he reach his greatest happiness: he becomes progressively unhappier and happier. In the moment when the contrast between both feelings becomes most terrifying, he perishes. For the outline.

16 [9]

“These are Zarathustra’s speeches on the seven solitudes”

–: they are meant to describe how distress grows along with happiness. Giving gifts, like creating, shows its other face.

Hard-heartedness in virtue:“© agony in compassion and justice:

isolation and homelessness for the friend of those who will come: creating as a kind of enchantment that brings with it a

disenchantment in regard to everything that is there: displea-

sure felt toward the most superior exemplars alienates us from

those who must be worked on: etc.

16 [10]

To seize for myself the total immorality of the artist in regard

to my material (humankind): this was the work of my last few years.

To seize for myself intellectual freedom and joy, in order to

be able to create and not to be tyrannized by alien ideals.

(Basically, it matters little what I had to break away from: yet

my favorite mode of breaking away was artistic in nature: i.e.,

I constructed an image of what had captivated me up until then: like Schopenhauer, Wagner, the Greeks (genius, saints, metaphysics, all previous ideals, the highest morality) – simultaneously a tribute out of gratitude.

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16 [11]

It was necessary to liberate myself from the delusion that nature would have to unlearn having goals.

Liberation from world-weariness. Now, for sake of this goal, my doctrine of the redemption of humanity from itself.

"now they know and are too disgusted to act p 35 Birth of Tragedy. "art saved them – and by means of art they saved their own life." Fundamental thought. My life from then on is the consequence.

To become artist (one who creates), saint (one who loves), and

philosopher (one who knows) in one person: – my practical goal!

The message: to find space and strength and courage to create. (Restricted to the human, as opposed to "world process" and "hinterworld")*8

To create for myself freedom from the old ideals: with the best motives, I turned in the direction of the opposing ideals: I

looked for the best even from this era.

I broke away: from education, from the kind of scholars that have existed up to now

"pessimist of the intellect."

emergence of "intellectual conscience": "what is true originally more useful and brings more honor? Mixed Opinions and Maxims p. 13.

My mockery of the pretensions of world-process advocates, my disbelief in a "drive for knowledge in itself," I allowed the

historical sense to develop out of only three drives. – Every-

thing was already there.

Hatred of Kantian obscurantism, of the Kantian doctrine of disinterested pleasure and of the quietism of the will.

16 [12]

Thanks to those who are there taking?!

16 [13]

Take pity on your foot so that it doesn't step into a morass:

Don't even bother kicking those who betray their friends."

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16 [14]

A history of origins® was required for overcoming ideals (philosopher, artist, saint) that have been held up to now. In place of saint-lovers, I put people who reimagine all phases of

culture lovingly-fairly: historical people of the most profound piety.

In place of geniuses, I put people who create human beings beyond themselves (new concept of art (against the artistry of artworks)

In place of philosophers, I put free spirits, who are superior

to scholars, researchers, critics and who, existing above many

ideals, still remain alive: who, without becoming Jesuits, and

in spite of all this, lay the foundations for the illogical nature

of existence: those who liberate us from morality.

Schopenhauer as Educator p. 60 "Only after, in our present or in some future incarnation, we have been taken up into that

most sublime order of philosophers, artists, and saints will a

new goal also be established for our love and our hate – in the

meantime, we have our task."*4

The value of error (delusion)

of forgetting finally the value of evil of enmity

16 [15]"°

My differences with Rée: the basic disagreement, dependence on an origin' and breaking away from it – not "egoistic" and "unegoistic"

He lacks a historical sense of the extraordinary variety in the codes of values comprising what is good.

H(uman,) A(ll Too Human) p. 79.7

Different derivation of the sense of justice and of vanity.

I am fighting against the notion that egoism is harmful and reprehensible: I want to create a clean conscience for egoism.

I claim that the herd instinct is originally the stronger and

more powerful one: that acting individually (not acting in accordance with lineage) has been perceived to be evil.

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they say: to find something reprehensible, only out of habit – – –

Ree thinks, utility is something trivial: his entire way of looking at things is dependent on moral prejudice.°®

p. 47 "when nothing about punishments reminds us that they

are a means of deterrence, then the impression must arise that they are a kind of retribution.""" Why? What is retribution any-way? He thinks that a sense of justice emerges because something appears {to be} retribution. But the concept of retribution has not been investigated. In addition, {he} overlooked the fact that all punishment emerges out of revenge.

"There can not be retribution for actions that are necessary"

p. 49° Of course there can be! He thinks there should not be, it would be unfair! i.e., he himself is operating under moral presuppositions.

Sense of justice i.e., to demand that retributive suffering occurs.

– According to Rée the consequence of 2 errors: 1) that punishment appears to be retribution 2) that the will is considered to be free.

He thinks that we would not undertake retribution if we considered our neighbors to be unfree. Now consider what retribution is here: first to prevent, to stop the harm from continuing. There cannot be retribution against a falling rock.

– He is right.

Rée errs when he allows a sense of justice to emerge from the punishment and as a result of the punishment: whereas punishments emerge from this sense of justice.

There must be retribution for those who injure us because they have undermined our awareness of our power: it is a crime against our self-esteem.

It is in no way sufficient: only those who want the well-being of others for their own sake have a morally good purpose, but we should ask what kind of well-being.

He is only interested in the emergence of the judgments "good" and "evil" – but the precise makeup of these actions, their

actual

utility (in relation to their assumed utility) is what interests me.

16 AUTUMN 1883 455

Morality initially self-glorification of the powerful and of the ruling caste.

Pleasure-displeasure are accompanying phenomena, not goals.

16 [16] Will-o'-the-wisp® in a swamp.

16 [17]

Substitute for revenge: as soon as we've grasped that it was the

violation of our feeling of power that so upset us, then we should

think about how we might increase our feeling of power. It is a

failure of intellect for us to insist that we are injuring the very

one doing the injuring and injuring that person even more.

But

this is still the case with our criminal justice system.

Here the

communal feeling of power is compromised when someone breaks the law: a brave undertaking, a noble act done in the best interest-

of the community, could quite easily be interpreted as being

directed against it! Individuals should provide compensation for

injuries that other individuals inflict: as something like benefactors

who overcompensate. – Yet if individuals have been insulted,

they should move to a higher level and thereby generate and extend their feeling of power. All the baseness of wretched people

should become a spur and a ladder for the noble. – But we should not have retribution for individual actions: actions are

symptoms of the whole being – there are no actions that are performed only once. As soon as I recognize: "people are capable

of that" – then my entire position toward them changes: from now on I perceive them to be my enemy and I wish not only to fight against them, but also to annihilate them. – "They are no

longer part of our group" is our rule of thumb.

My program: do away with punishment: for us. Counter-retribution as nonsense. (If something is evil, then whoever performs the counter-retribution is certainly committing the same evil.) The purpose is not to deter, but rather to protect

ourselves against further harm (along with irritation at the fact

that we were too gullible)

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16 [18]

Contra Rée: where there is suffering, then something has been done contrary to utility – in nature, something contrary to purpose.

16 [19]

If it is true that the standpoint of the common good has determined the value of what is not self-interested: now we must still ask: is the judgment true, justified? Is a benevolent

person beneficial?

16 [20]

Wherever there are living things, there are sudden explosions

of force: the subjective feeling is that “free will” is involved. The

number and power of these explosions initially determine the value of a living thing: then the direction that is given to these

explosions. When we speak of “motives for action,” we always mean only “motives for direction.”

16 [21]

Goal: to build up the entire body and not just the brain!

16 [22]

We must think just as ruthlessly about the masses as nature does: they preserve the species.

16 [23]

The face of Jesuitism grins from behind my first phase: I mean: consciously holding on to an illusion and being forced to incorporate this illusion as a basis for civilization.”

Or also:

Buddhism and the demand for nothingness (the Schopenhauerian contradiction between theory and practice not sustainable). Wagner succumbed to the first danger.

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16 [24]

NB! History of superior humans. Breeding better humans is enormously more painful. To demonstrate through Zarathus-

tra the ideal of the kind of sacrifices required for this:
to leave
homeland, family, fatherland. Life lived under the contempt
of prevailing ethics (despised). Agony of experiments and fail-
ures. Breaking away from all of the enjoyment offered by the
older ideals (they taste somewhat threatening, somewhat for-
eign to the tongue)

16 [25]

Delight in causing pain, because it is accompanied by an
increase in the feeling of power: most intense when preceded
by some kind of diminishment – thus, in revenge.
Delight in doing good evolved in completely the same way
– and generosity is sublimated revenge and for that reason a
much greater delight.

16 [26]®

Every living thing expands its force outward as far as it
can
and subjugates what is weaker: in this way, it takes delight
in
itself. The increasing “anthropomorphism” within this tend-
ency
consists in the ever more subtle perception of how difficult
it is
really to incorporate the other: how the extensive damage
may
indeed demonstrate our power over it, yet at the same time
alienate us still further from its will – thus making it
less
easily subjugated.

16 [27]

Moral valuation initially refers to the distinction between
superior and inferior human beings (or castes) morality is
initially
self-glorification of the powerful: and contempt in regard
to the
powerless. Not “good” and “evil,” but rather “noble” and
“base,”
is the original feeling. Only then are the differing actions
and
characteristics called noble, and the ones in opposition to
them
called base.

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16 [28]

Thieves do not act in order to take delight in power, they

do
not project themselves into the effect that their actions
produce in others. No more than do robbers, or people who kill
others in order to take something from them. But they reveal
that they are afraid of us, that's why --

16 [29]

In what way is injury an injustice? -- The need for retri-
bution emerges when injury occurs: what is this? Not to be
con-
fused with the feeling that we have recognized an enemy and
that we will make it impossible for this enemy to do us fur-
ther

damage. Or with the intention of recovering what was taken
from us or some equivalent. A bitterness remains. Enemies
are

not felt to be bad in themselves: but the person injured al-
most

always feels self recrimination: we were too careless, our
weap-

ons were not in good condition, we should have seen the
warning signs long ago, etc. This disappointment in
ourselves

-- thus a diminished self-esteem -- is the main reason for the
bitterness we feel in revenge: and even the motivation for
sub-

tlety in carrying out our revenge.

Because everything is paid for and some equivalent for
every-

thing exists, fantasizing has even led to inventing equival-
ents

for harm: and to speaking of retribution. But basically all
of

this is concerned with something else, with much more than a
repayment. Retribution is merely hypocrisy and whitewashing
for those who avenge themselves. "Guilt."

The feeling of desire for revenge ceases when the injuring
parties abase themselves, make restitution for the harm: at
that point they are vanquished.

The intention to do harm is originally not even considered:
rather the fact that someone has been harmed and how much.

Punishment follows at that point. The harm inflicted is paid
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back -- is the oldest form, not a hostile mentality. Outrage
emerges in response to the harm done, and so to the enemies'
success, not to hostility toward them. It is the feeling of

the
 vanquished – the demand for retribution: not the feeling
 that
 wrong has been done. ‘
 Revenge, the demand for retribution, is not the feeling that
 wrong has been done, but rather that I have been vanquished
 – and that I must now restore my standing by any means
 necessary.
 Injustice emerges only after an agreement is broken, in
 other words, when peace and loyalty are violated. This is
 out-
 rage about an unworthy action, unworthy of the assumed
 equivalence of feelings. Therefore, something base, some-
 thing
 contemptible must be involved which refers to a lower level.
 The counter-intention can only be to move unworthy beings to
 this lower level: thus separating them from us, expelling
 them,
 humiliating them, disgracing them. Meaning of punishment.
 The meaning of punishment is not to deter, but rather to
 move someone to a lower place in the social order: this per-
 son
 is no longer counted among our equals.
 Every measure that achieves this is adequate. “Ostracism.”
 The system of punishment must develop in this direction!
 16 [30]°”
 Zarathustra 3: The others are allowed to obey: and their
 vanity demands that they do not appear to be dependent on
 great people but rather on “principles.”
 16 [31]
 Bitterness about ourselves in matters of revenge transforms
 itself
 in lesser natures very quickly into being outraged toward
 enemies
 and into wishing to accuse them of something contemptible
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 16 [32]
 How powerful people are overpowering and arrogant in
 regard to the subjugated: the development of prudence and
 anthropomorphism allows this overpowering and this arrogance
 to be intellectualized more and more. But why should power
 not
 want to take delight in itself!
 The supreme relationship remains, that of those who create
 toward their material: this is the ultimate form of arrog-
 ance

and dominance. In this way, the organic form is brought to completion for the first time: thus resembling the way in which the body is dependent on impulses of the will and takes

delight in itself when it is under the most control.

16 [33] Liberation from Morality.

Organic-moral® (competition of the affects and supremacy of one affect over the intellect"°)

Revenge, injustice, punishment.

Anyone who believes in good and evil can never treat evil as a means of achieving good; and every teleological worldview that doesn't completely break with ethics is /ost.

There could be a history of value judgments concerning food: in that case, the basic question would still remain: what

value is involved in this or that having been eaten? – Thus, the question remains: what is the value of things having always

been done in this or that way, apart from the question: what kind of values have been assigned to the actions up to now?

—

The history of value-estimations up to now, and their rationale,

is something other than the estimation itself.

No person will say: stones that are falling constitute moral-

ity. Well then! human beings climb – and that is also not morality!

The collective conscience. The atavism in the estimation of unegoistic people.

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16 [34]

Weaker people give in, and subjugate themselves, when revenge

is senseless.

16 [35]"

"Whatever Zarathustra has decided, this will happen: how should his great soul be capable of changing its resolve!"

16 [36]?

Let us hold fast to the notion that humans are the predator of all predators! It is said that humans love themselves: but

this is precious little love!

16 [37]

Zarathustra recognizes that he is also not there for his friends "Who are my friends!" Neither for the people, nor

for
individuals! Neither for the many nor for the few! To overcome
friendship! Sign of his self-overcoming at the beginning of
III

Emerson p. 4267? Depiction of the sage.

16 [38]

When he sees through Pana, Zarathustra dies from compassion for her compassion. Before that, the moment of supreme contempt (supreme bliss!)

Everything must be fulfilled, namely, everything from the preface.

16 [39]

The final circumstance, remaining silent in the most refined way hinders all great success: as soon as h(uman) beings are completely in harmony with the truth, they move all of nature.

III Part Zarathustra

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16 [40]

This has to do with more than giving gifts: with creating, with overpowering! Fundamental concept of the second solitude (Beginning of IIL.)

Our "gifts" are dangerous!

16 [41]

Controlling humankind for the purpose of overcoming it
Overcoming by means of doctrines that bring about its downfall, except for those who can survive it.'°

16 [42]

First everyone turns away from Zarathustra (this to be depicted in stages'). Zarathustra enraptured, doesn't notice.
Pana

wants to kill him. /n the moment when she wields the dagger, Zarathustra understands everything and dies in pain from this

compassion. This is to be made clear!

16 [43]

The "truth," the "annihilation of illusions," "even of the moral

illusion" – as the great means of overpowering humankind (of its self-destruction!) Part III.

NB. All the sufferings associated with Zarathustra's development as depicted here are to be depicted as much greater than what superior humans suffer on account of their visitors.

16 [44]

"It was out of love that I caused the greatest suffering:
now I

melt away at the suffering I caused –

16 [45]

When everyone has gone, Zarathustra reaches out his hand
to the serpent: "what advice does my cleverness offer me?" –
it bites him. The eagle tears it to pieces, the lion hurls
itself on

top of the eagle. When Zarathustra saw his animals fighting,
he died.

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16 [46]

No one has time for me? Very well, then I shall wait. What
is the deal with a time that "has no time"!"

16 [47]

Zarathustra's thanksgiving prayer of a convalescent.'®

16 [48]

Zarathustra as "autumn," as "plowshare," etc. – different
P melodies!

16 [49]

Speech on the innocence of becoming. Beatitude" sub specie
aeterni 8?

The consecration of what is smallest.

Those who make vows.

The new kings

The breaking of the tablets. (From Part 4 beginning of Scene
3)

Great humans as rivals of majestic nature.

The two movements (toward the last humans and toward
the superhumans).

The redemption of evil people.

As children, a much longer youth, encompassing many coun-
tries and industries and trades.

The new teachers as precursors of the greatest sculptors
(imposing their type)

The most burdensome knowledge as hammer.

Praise of mercy (for the sake of those to come)

Summoning enemies! (we need them for the sake of our ideal!

To transform our enemies of equal breeding into gods and
thus to raise ourselves up and transform ourselves!

Those who create, those who love, those who know, unified
by power.®!

The will to suffer – to feel suffering deeply as means of
transformation.

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The parasite as the bad person. We must not be merely

those who enjoy existence – ignoble.
The rejoicing conscience: as prayer.
Contra praise and blame. To shine after centuries; predeter-
min(ation) of the future.
Overpowering the past: and then forgetfulness that heals,
the divine circle.
The holy laughter.
The song of solace (set to my music).
The teaching of return is the turning point of history.
16 [50]

Solitude necessary for a time, so that our being becomes
whole and permeated – completely healed and hardened.
New form of community: to stand our ground as warriors.
Otherwise the mind grows tired. No “gardens,” and just
“withdrawing from the masses.” War (but without gunpow-
der!) between different thoughts! and their armies!
New nobility, through breeding. Foundations festivals for
families.
A new division of the day; physical exercise for all ages.
Competition as principle.
Sexual love as competition with the principle of what is
becoming, what is to come, as the prize. – “Ruling” is
taught,
practiced, hard-heartedness as well as mercy. As soon as one
condition has been mastered, it is essential to strive for a
new
one.

To allow ourselves to be taught by evil people and to give
even them the opportunity to compete. To use those who
make things decadent. – This should be the justice of pun-
ish-
ment, that the offender should be able to be used as an ex-
peri-
mental subject (for new nourishment): this is the consecra-
tion
of punishment, that here an offender will be used up for the
greatest benefit of those who are to come.

We spare our new community because it is the bridge to our
ideal of the future. And we work for it and let others work
for it.

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Places of residence.

Kind of community.

Wars.

The new nobility.

Experiments (punishments etc.)

To redeem the woman in women.

The many wanderings of the individual's soul. Long youth.

The time for solitude.

82

The choice of places of residence, new (Indic peoples as cau-

tionary example!)

To redeem the woman in women!®?

Physical strength should be on the side of the greatest thoughts – that's how long the war between the different thoughts must last!

16 [51] Plan for Zarathustra III

Zarathustra 3: the transition from freethinker and hermit to having to rule: gift-giving is transformed – from giving, there

emerged the will's exercising its compulsion to take. The tyranny

of the artist initially as self-disciplining and self-tempering!

Psychology of those who rule. (The desire for friends reveals

itself as desire for tools of the artist!)

Zarathustra 3: first fleeing from the "inexpressible truth" skepticism, self-ridicule, voluntary blindness, increasing mis-

ery, feeling of weakness. The 7 solitudes – attempt to find refuge, to rest somewhere in a past worldview. Objections to his

doctrine present themselves. The seducers as well. (To insert:

"the song of solace.")

The most profound suffering is not for his own sake, but rather for the sake of those dearest to him who bleed to death

on account of his doctrine. – But following this experience, 466 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Zarathustra simultaneously rises to the greatest hard-hearted-

ness against himself and against those nearest to him and thinks only of the "future."

At the end, the lion as Zarathustra's third animal – symbol of his ripeness and tenderness.*4

"Thanksgiving Prayer of a Convalescent": Part 3 concludes with this.

16 [52]

The love for friends would like to force Zarathustra to

with-

hold his great truth: even after he has admitted it to himself.

– This is the problem of those who rule: they sacrifice those they love to their ideal.

16 [53]

The band of those sacrificing themselves gathered at Zarathustra's grave. Previously they fled: now, when they find him dead, they become the heirs of his soul and they raise themselves up to his height. (This the last scene in Zarathustra 4 –

“the great noon” – clear – unending sky)

16 [54]

Everything warns Zarathustra about speaking further: omens. He is interrupted. One of them kills himself, another goes mad. Mood of divine exuberance® in the artist –: it must come to light. After he has simultaneously demonstrated the truth of the return and shown the superhumans, he is overwhelmed by compassion.

Exaltation increasing within him (én this exaltation he goes through all stages of evil – but for the sake of his goal.

Here he is

the teacher of evil, of hard-heartedness etc.) and “glow of the

Alps” – gathering gloom among his listeners. Rain at the end etc.

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16 [55] Plan for Zarathustra 4.

1. The victory parade, the plague city, the symbolic funeral pyre. 30

deeds. 30

. The last speech with omens, interruptions, rain, death. 30
great noon – forebodingly clear and eerie. 30

w

16 [56]

“Do you want this once again?”

Clairvoyant about his gift-giving and teaching, about his love for his friends.

He feels the supreme responsibility resting on his shoulders.

What happiness!

Will to suffer and the strength of character on the path (cold people, hard-hearted people, parasites).

Every authentic life an experiment!

Morality up to now based in weakness: we wanted authority and we designed leisure for ourselves.

The contradiction of goodness and creativity: this is the problem of wisdom.

16 [57]

Even the drives of future humankind are also already present and demand to be satisfied – although we are not yet consciously familiar with them. Thus, even in great individuals

there is an apparent concern for as yet nonexistent needs.

16 [58]

These are the speeches of the seven solitudes, which Zarathustra spoke to his heart after he had abandoned his friends and even his animals; and at that time, he would have

loved to have abandoned himself.

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16 [59]

The woman in women should be emancipated!®®

16 [60]

It is not enough to proclaim a doctrine: we must also change human beings by force, so that they accept it! – Zarathustra finally grasps this.

16 [61]

To overcome the past within us: to combine drives in a new way and to direct them all together toward one goal: – very difficult! The evil drives are certainly not the only drives that

must be overcome – even the so-called good drives must be overpowered and newly consecrated!

The temptations:

to rest in a worldview from the past.

Derisive skepticism and self-disintegration: what could you “create” then!

“you aren’t strong enough! Leave it to someone stronger!”

Enjoy your fatigue! Admire yourself!

convince yourself that your compassion is a virtue and that you are sacrificing your knowledge for the happiness of others.

Go ahead and admit to yourself what is meant by this will to create – imperiousness, which cannot be satisfied just any-

where. “Friends?” You want to have tools!

And so why tell this truth in the first place! Even if you were

allowed to believe that it is the truth! There are really no

con-

straints on you anymore! No "obligation to the truth"! You destroy in all others the pleasure they take in what is before them, you are the teacher of the great fatigue it-self!

you disempower virtue and cause it to be praised less, thus desired less. You yourself rob humankind of the force with which it could pursue the goal!

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16 [62]

The degree of psychological subtlety decides whether people interpret their actions as good or evil. And not only subtlety,

but also their desire for revenge, bad moods, good nature, fri-

volity etc.

16 [63]

NB. The thought itself will not be articulated in the third part:

only prepared for.

First: critique of everything taught up to now.

Which means of consolation were lost to him.

faith and trust in a supreme wisdom and goodness

faith in that which is good, the voice of duty etc.

Evil conscience (the best conscience is influenced by fear, mistrust of ourselves, skepticism, having to keep silent, distortion of, etc.)

The song of those who fly.

Humans as rivals of majestic nature.

Fear of the consequences of the doctrine: maybe the best natures perish because of it? The worst accept it?

Solution Zarathustra III: you must elevate yourself above morality, you have seen through it – all of your misery was the result of it.

there is no other way for human beings to overcome themselves.

Keeping the smallest secret cripples all of his strength: he feels that he has avoided a thought up to now, – now the thought hurls itself upon him with all of its force! It is a wres-

tling match: who is strong enough, Zarathustra or the thought?

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What is the point of truth? – It has become the strongest drive, the will to truth! Zarathustra can do nothing else!®"

– and whether I count forward from now or backward from now: I hold the belt of infinity in my hand and – – – Fools say: “but at that point infinity would certainly have been completed”: yet we must be exact in the use of our words

and never call something a beginning which at some other time we call an end.

His reassurance: the effect cannot be anticipated!

the greatest thought does its work in the slowest and most delayed way!

its most immediate effect is a substitute for faith in immor-

talities: does it increase good will toward life?

Maybe it is not true: – may others wrestle with it!

16 [64]

1. Solitude in shame and weakness and silence in the face of a great thought.

What is the point of truth!

2. Solitude, in which all the old reasons for solace have been lost.

4. Solitude without friends, indeed with the awareness that we are sacrificing our friends.

6. Solitude in eternity, beyond morality: the creative one and goodness. No alternative solution exists except to create

another being that does not suffer as we do.

Determinism:#® “I am a fatum® for everything that is coming!” – is my answer to determinism!

7. Solitude of a sick person. Song of solace. Growing weary, growing silent. Sanctified through suffering.

13 p(ages) each. Each time at the end, the thought that overcomes.

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NB. All concerns are signs of the will to suffer, a deepening of

pain: when the pain is most intense, Z(arathustra) throws it aside:

greatest concluding moment (the lion): I will this!!!

Hymn at the end: the victorious one. (10 pages)

16 [65]

The third part is Zarathustra’s self-overcoming, as a model for humankind’s self-overcoming – for the benefit of the superhumans.

For this, it is necessary to overcome morality.

You sacrifice your friends – they are profound enough to per-

ish as a result: and they didn't create the thought (which still occupies me!)

This as a last counterargument which confronts Zarathustra – the strongest enemy. Now Zarathustra is becoming ripe. In Part 4 Zarathustra dies when he notices the pain of his friends: and they abandon him. – But after his death, his spirit comes over them.

Institutions as the aftereffects of great individuals and as a means of planting great individuals and of rooting them – until finally fruit emerges.

16 [66]

Wrestling contest for the use of the power that humankind represents! Zarathustra calls for everyone to join this wrestling contest. (Part 4 Zarathustra's speeches)

16 [67]

The eudaemonistic-)social ideals lead human beings back – perhaps they are targeting a very useful worker-species – they invent the ideal slaves of the future – the lower caste that can't be missing!"°

The "happiness of those who know" and their obtuseness up to now about the fruits of knowledge – song of ridicule. 472 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

16 [68]

The short-lived force of artists' drives – they stop near the image of their ideal and they themselves no longer even follow the ideal – song of ridicule. Not to mention the audience!?! They should be teachers – these artists!

16 [69]

How much the field marshal sacrifices, the prince, those responsible to themselves – this is to be highly revered!

16 [70]

Actually, humans always try to use collectives to make the great individual expendable etc. But they are completely dependent on those role models.

16 [71]

The conflict of those who rule is the struggle between their love for those who are more distant from them and their love

for
those who are closest to them.
Being a creator and goodness are not opposites, but rather
one
and the same thing, yet with a more distant or a closer per-
spective.
16 [72] The weak must obey.
16 [73]
To find the measure and the mean in striving beyond
humankind: the supreme and most powerful kind of human
being must be found! To continue depicting the supreme ten-
dency in miniature – perfection, ripeness, glowing health,
mild emanation of power. To work as artists do at their
daily
tasks, to bring us closer to perfection with each work, to
be the
best brother there is. Honesty in admitting motives to our-
selves, as befits those who are powerful.
NB. everything can be ruined by the madness of longing!
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16 [74]
NB. The inner difficulties of Part 3 have to appear at the
end as completely unnecessary: when faced with the general
insight, they must cancel themselves out.
16 [75]
Every sacrifice made by someone who rules is repaid a hun-
dred times over.
16 [76]
General insight perhaps: the organic itself is the law, we
can-
not do anything else – absolute determinism. The many possi-
bilities that we see, confuse us.
16 [77]
The great mass, force of the individual is wasted in this
way,
like that of the sun. Or???

16 [78]?
A fact, a work, is newly eloquent for every age and for
every
new kind of human being. History is always articulating new
truths.
16 [79]
Zarathustra 3. This entire distress, with the aversion to
suf-
fering, came from the feeling that the force was not yet
sufficient

– an instinct of weakness that initially hindered action
(even hindered the articulation of the thought!) – The will to suffer

is immediately present when the power is strong enough.
“The stillest hour” was a temptress.

16 [80]

NB. Zarathustra’s mood not madly impatient for the superhumans!

it is serene, can wait, but everything that is done has taken

on meaning as the way and the means to get there – and must be done well and completely.

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Serenity of the great torrent!!! Consecration of the smallest!!! all disquiet, fervent longing, all disgust should be depicted

and overcome in Part 3!

(Gentleness, mildness of Parts 1 and 2), etc. everything a sign

of a force that is not yet sure of itself!)

In the midst of Zarathustra’s convalescence, Caesar stands there, unrelenting, benevolent – the split between being creator,

benevolence, and wisdom is annihilated. Light, serenity, no

exaggerated longing, happiness in a moment that has been properly

applied, made eternal!

16 [81]

Beyond midlife – irrevocably sacrificed – no going back!

16 [82]

(4) Speeches: great honesty in regard to morality – as befits

those who are powerful

Compilation of things in life that take hold of us

16 [83] (Zarathustra 3.)

Recapitulation: to create superhumans by every means. But you fall in love with your friends and with yourself! The thought

became a burden to us.

1. Clairvoyance. tossed about on the ocean

. Summoning up the truth.

. Beyond midlife – irrevocably sacrificed.

. Song of mockery about the pessimists.

. Las fatum.

. Majestic nature and human beings.
. Song of those who fly.
. What it means to be a friend! Praise of friends (who perished) of the quiet world-beautifiers who create, praise of ho pe – not before now!
oN Aun Aw DN
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9. beyond good and evil
12. Commiseration with those who rule and with their sufferings.
18. In his desire for commiseration, he seeks out his animals and finds the cave destroyed.
20. Temptation to suicide. The serpent in the high mountains.
22. Rainbow. Lioness with flock of doves. Praise of a primordially determined nature that turns everything into its own happiness.
against the nonsense of reclusiveness
16 [84] (Zarathustra 4.) 1. The invitation. 2. The victory parade. 3. The convalescents' thanksgiving song. 4. The great noon.
5. The new community. I found that humans had become inferior, minor virtues, minor misdeeds.*
6. Where to? (Places of residence)
7. The new nobility and its education. (Multiplicity and unity) (Powerful and puny people)"
8. The woman in women"
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Bridging "poor and rich."
12. Punishment and evil people. The new leniency for the sake of those who are coming. Evil people praiseworthy as destroyers, for destruction is necessary." Afterward as a source of power.
13. Life as an experiment: happiness in figuring things out or in experimenting (skepticism). Death and the desire to see ourselves yield because we are inhibiting life.
14. The breaking of the tablets. The ideal "lawgiver." A herald's proclamation.
15. The I sanctified. "Selfishness" and "imperiousness" above
all. Teichmüller) p. 131.°8 Called heretical up to now, all drives, because too strong in the wrong position, rehabilitated."

16. The redemption of those who have passed away. The great noon filled to the brim with unified opposites.!°°

17. Praise of cool dialectical reason, as kingly = strongly influential for feelings. The grateful eye. Warding off the monstrous.

18. The sanctification of laughter and dance. (the body as testimony of growth)

20. The innocence of becoming. The struggle with chance. the new "immortality" "will to suffer"

16 [85]

Concerning Zarathustra's convalescence at the conclusion of the third part.

Zarathustra musing like a god about whether he will communicate his thought to humans. What motivates a god in relation to humans?

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To reinterpret religion from this standpoint: a god in his relationship with humans.

Zarathustra 3. "I myself am happy" – when he has abandoned humans, he returns to himself. It avoids him like a cloud.

How the superhuman being must typically /ive, like an Epicurean god.

a kind of divine suffering is the content of Zarathustra 3. the Auman condition of the lawgiver is only cited as an example

his intense love for his friends seems like an illness to him

– he is again at peace.

When invitations arrive, he gently avoids them.

Main doctrine: It lies in our power to remake suffering into a

blessing, poison into nourishment. Will to suffer.

What it means to be human flew toward me, its shadow surrounded me, then I felt weakness.

16 [86]

To rule? To impose my type on others? Dreadful! Isn't observing a variety of other people precisely what makes me happy? Problem.'®!

To challenge to a contest of power precisely those who like to conceal themselves and who would like to live for themselves – even the wise, pious, silent people in our country! Mocking their enjoyment of solitude!

All creative natures fight for influence even when they live alone – "posthumous fame" is merely a false expression for what they want.

The enormous task of those who rule, those who educate themselves – they must model within themselves the kind of human beings and peoples over which they want to rule: they must already have become masters there!

All virtue and selfovercoming makes sense only as a kind of preparation for those who rule!

Against all those who merely enjoy! Solitude, too, as self enjoyment, even the solitude of those who mortify themselves.

478 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

A diamond sword cuts every darkness into pieces for me: I have now become clairvoyant – I have certainly been obsessed with clairvoyance for far too long!!°?

Good days want to walk on good feet!©%

Demand: the new law must be capable of being actualized – and overcoming and the higher law must grow out of the actualization. Zarathustra makes room for the law by canceling the “law of laws,” morality.

Laws as backbone.

to work on them and to create, as we perfect them. The previous slave mentality on trial!

Zarathustra himself has become a sage who rejoices in his foolishness and a pauper who rejoices in his wealth. Scene: the

fool and the pauper in 4.

I do not want to establish a single ideal of the sage, but rather a hundred ideals of the fool! Zarathustra 4.

Against the ferocious theatrical stoic magnificence of the “sage.”

The lawgiver type, its development and its suffering.

What's the point of giving laws at all?

Zarathustra is the herald who summons many lawgivers.

(For 4) Initially law-giving. Then, after the prospect of breeding superhumans has been broached by means of this law-giving – great gruesome moment! Zarathustra proclaims the doctrine of recurrence – which only now has become bearable, even for him for the first time!

16 [87]

If our fellow humans are merely one form of our perceptions: then it follows that ruling is merely one form of se/frule: and

the will to be ruler is = the greatest victory over our own fear

and compassion and transformation of the other into our function – therefore production of an organism.

16 [88]

I will not give to (those) other people the rights that I
 have
 won for myself: instead they should steal them for them-
 selves!
 16 AUTUMN 1883 479
 as I do – and may they take them and rip them away from
 me! In this way, there must exist a law which is an exten-
 sion of
 me, as if it wanted to make all people in my image: so that,
 in
 contrast to my image, individuals may discover themselves
 and make themselves stronger.
 New appraisal of human beings: advancing the question:
 how much power is in them?
 how much multiplicity of drives?
 how much ability to communicate and absorb?
 Those who rule as supreme type.
 To make the past fertile and to breed the future – let that
 be my present time!
 Zarathustra himself the jester who jumps over the poor
 tightrope walker – for 3) self-mockery.
 First scene of 3) perhaps “the wanderer” and a conversation
 with lightning that suddenly blazes forth: thus does his
 will
 blaze forth suddenly for him.
 Mockery of the slavish subjugation in morality (under the
 ancient law of somebody or other)
 To form a long-lasting individual (a people) in order to
 translate their thoughts into flesh blood and will
 Those who take a right for themselves will not give this
 right
 to others – but rather will be their opponents in the act of
 taking it for themselves. the love of the father who resists
 the
 son,!04
 The great educators are like nature: they must pile up
 barri-
 ers so that the barriers may be overcome.
 Against all who enjoy: – ignoble to confront life in only
 this way! To accept all enjoyment as rest! In this way, true
 enjoyment for the first time!
 We are punished most severely for our virtues.!°
 A person makes an action valuable: but how should the action
 make the person valuable!
 5
 480 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

It is cool, the moon is shining, no cloud is in the sky – there's no point in living.

16 [89]

Zarathustra 3 Beginning. Recapitulation. You want to teach about the superhumans!°° – but you have fallen in love with your friends and with yourself and made life into a refreshment.

The blessed isles make you soft – now you become depressed and passionate and berate your enemies. Sign of weakness: you

avoid a thought.

But you should convince the world and convince humans to crush themselves.

(The reformer languid in his own community: his enemies are not strong enough. Thus his greatest enemy must emerge, a thought.

The thought as an objection to life and to the continuation of life)

16 [90]

Regret: this is revenge on ourselves.

and I give this advice to my enemies and to all those who spit and spew:

as the teacher of the great contempt (The penultimate)

How could I bear it otherwise, teaching you the great contempt? –!7

[17 = N VI 6. Autumn 1883]

17 W!

And when someday you can no longer endure life, you must attempt to win its favor – for such has always been the artful

strategy of the greatest sages.

Truly their most artful, boldest strategy was to believe in a

god just when they felt the devil coming too close.

They learned to switch names for things: and so things became switched around in their minds – behold, this is the artfulness of the greatest sages in its entirety!

Most people are too crazy to be self-interested – their happiness makes all of them crazy.

They sacrifice everything for one thing – this is a kind of love; this willfulness and self-absorption loom over all people.

Their intense insanity bubbles forth out of their love – but it is a poor calculator and despises huckster virtues."

Yet huckster virtue and the huckster's money-grubbing? fingers

and cold eye – this is even beneath the dignity of an animal.

Everything that can be bought is worth little: I spit this doctrine into the faces of hucksters.

There are things, whether the hucksters know it or not – in whose proximity money sounds completely shameless.

Money passes through all fingers: therefore learn to handle money with kid gloves.

Praise be to puny poverty: for all hucksters scheme after great wealth.

482 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

17 2 Hucksters Teachers

Tools

Princes.

they all deserve each other?

Concerning evil people (imperious people – this is the mark of evil people)

17 [3]°

Those who have always spared themselves a lot will still finally get sick from sparing themselves too much.

He speaks roughly – but not from a rough soul: every gust of wind makes him speak more hoarsely, this sensitive little thing!

Ultimately, the best, most fertile land (concerning evil people)

7 [47]

Zarathustra makes fun of previous attacks on evil and selfish people, on passionate people (for the benefit of weaklings)

77 [5]

And we often teach despairing people to be strong only by telling them about their weakness.®

Some are gluttons, others nibblers – both contemptible!" Begetters and breeders!°

17 [el Against noise

You can mold and remold the soul by means of nutrition with salts baths and exercise – how could you not bring healing to sick souls?

17 AUTUMN 1883 483

There were times when oaths and vows were made on a mortar !?

In order to change the soul it is necessary to change the body.!?

Holy iron shavings and bone fragments, Egyptian nights locked up in canisters,

having thrown coal on the fire, I have completely smothered
it: it was too small anyway

17 [7]

Oh these narrow dull huckster-souls! Whenever money
jumps into the money box, the hucksters jump in along with
it.

Whose souls have been a money belt and whose happiness
has been dirty pieces of paper – how could their blood ever
become clean?

It still flows lifeless and poisonous and foul smelling unto
the tenth generation.

stagnant and foamy

17 [8]

We have unlearned this: there is no virtue for all,
there are superior and inferior human beings: equal rights
for all is the most extraordinary injustice.

17 [9]!°

On hucksters.!"

On substitute teachers.!8

On princes.

On laws.

On pious people.

On speed.

The great curse.

The city.

– On science – Visit of the fool. – Mocking.

– Zarathustra seeks the cave. Symbol.

– Hermit. – Speech.

484 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

17 [10]

And if I cannot live the way I wish,!° then I have no wish
to

live – this is how the most saintly people still think."°

So, does a drive want to be satisfied? Does it want freedom
and peace from itself? Has any will ever willed not to will?
That it creates, this is what drives all drives: and prob-
ably

that it also sleeps in for a while – (in order to) become
fully

awake while creating!

But you distorted the essence of willing into unwillingness
and into willing against itself

you misinterpret(ed) the voice of the weary will

So, is sleep an invention in response to death? And would it
be the case that whoever wants to sleep is someone who is
weary of dying? The liveliest person can snuffle and

snore.?!

Scribblers and screamers, hasty idlers, those panting with ambition, pushy and shameless people."

"The virtue of daily life suffices" – we must learn modesty even in virtue??

17 [11]*4 On diminishment.

The big city. as a stake at which people are burned:

1) the deep thought etc.

clumsy as a corpse"

17 [12]

Beware, you who are the wealthiest: your puny acts of charity bring impatience and spark more outrage than any miserli-

ness: you drip like wide-bottomed bottles with all-too-narrow

necks – bottles like these have already had their necks broken

many times.

These neighbors and their puny distress, this city and its meager happiness – this slowly chips away at your strength; you are unlearning how to inflict great pain.

17 AUTUMN 1883 485

17 [3]?

Contented sows or dying gladiators – don't you have any other options?

A lustful eye cast over a bilious soul?'

Whenever something dead is dug up, a lot of living things always get sick; sickness and harmful vapors live under excavated earth.

Gravediggers dig themselves into illness, – – –

We begin as imitators and end up imitating ourselves – this is the last childhood.

The compassion of the greatest people is firm," like the hand-shake of a giant.

I wanted to be a light to them, but I made them blind; this is every sun's complaint, it puts eyes out.

How do I get through the city gate? said Zarathustra – I have unlearned how to be a dwarf.

The greatest thing about great people is what is maternal in them: the father is merely a matter of chance.

For them, being forced to give birth means the future; they do not understand what their happiness will be – they don't gloat about any kind of "freedom."

From my snow-capped peaks on downwards, I find every

flower, I am all-too-human, I am also still almost-animal.
My fury still obeys me
and little children do not always come to him who suffers
them to come.??

486 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

You cough, but this is no objection to strong winds.
Your maw roars: food and drink! Your belly roars in response,
lots! Your lusting eye: good!
Alas, says Zarathustra, I cannot exempt myself from hell
– the underworld, where everything dead rises up against me,
and where even the shades speak: life is torture.?!
Your ailments set themselves against you and accuse you on
account of the virtues you gloat about: and what doesn't
suit
your body, how should this – – -*?
Your street talking is making you sicker than your street
walkers: and precisely these are your most secret sicknesses.

There is a great hypocrisy among you: those who command
pretend to have the virtues of those who obey.
Born to rule, but where would I have found a teacher who
could teach me how to rule? That's why I am trying to persuade
them when I should be commanding them!
Yet persuasion is the flattery that a superior shows to an
inferior and that a lord shows to – – –
And not until everything goes as we will, does everything
also go as we wish.
It writhes as if about to be martyred: it does not speak, it
subjects itself to the martyrdom of keeping quiet.
Oh, Zarathustra advocate of life! You must also be the
advocate of suffering!'
Human beings must become more evil. Zarathustra 4 this is
the greatest suffering for me – I must make them more evil!
and wherever I see the sticky fingers of a huckster, I
prefer
to draw the short straw.

17 AUTUMN 1883 487

The black sad sea lies before you – you must cross even
beyond that, too!34
to live among dwarves
I see crumpled houses – a child probably took them out of
the box. Crumple(d) souls
Time feels different in the dark than in the light.
spoiled by many puny triumphs – he has always had it
easy – intimate and welcoming, but lowly like a door through

which a tall person does not enter."

Wise forgetfulness and the art of sailing in every wind –
two new virtues.*°

Only those who begin steering toward their goal have the
wind at their back.

To outwit chance and lead it around by the hand – suffer
chance to come to me, it is innocent like a little child.⁷
The doctrine of life Zarathustra 4 terrible-dithyrambic
Seed of life strewn from star to star."

Beauty cloaks the man

– to become smooth and hard-hearted, we must bring our
secret solitude into the crowd.??

"it hurts, therefore it is bad" – this is the oldest and
most

recent conclusion and the basest of all base things.

Ever since I have understood this origin of bad things, I
have laughed at all this babble about good and bad.

Beyond what is good and bad

488 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

I respect virtue when it is the caution of someone who is
pregnant: but what do I care about the virtue of those who
are

infertile!

17 [14]

sparing of ourselves, the wise forgetting, the bliss of
those

who hope, the generosity of those who also conceal their
aloneness,?? – – –

Fear has made humans tame: their weakness has grown out of
the fear they feel of their monster "selfishness and imperi-
ousness."

So why, then, do you howl through the night, you monster?

You writhe, you torment yourself, what could bring you com-
fort?

You are sleeping poorly, an evil dream has come to you, you
are groaning under the weight of evil thoughts."

You want the best for yourselves and you still want even the
best for me, now then – what would be the point of hurting
you with my pain!

There would be so much of you that would be ruined

because of me, and so little that would be improved: let me
be

silent!

I am sad for you and I have a grudge against myself on your
account: alas that I am (not) strong enough to deliver you
from

evil dreams!

Your eyes stay open, they are sleepy, half-dead, sad eyes:
your mouth is open, a gurgling choking sound
the fear of you had crippled them – awe lets them walk again
warm breath, limbs stretched out
drunk with sleep – an open eye and yet a vacant stare, he
– lost to himself – seeking something, sullen
I trust you even more in a storm
your countless jaws and bared teeth
17 AUTUMN 1883 489

Thus my destiny lies before me like the sea, in dark sadness,
chagrined, aged, still drunk with sleep, with open mouth,
dreaming.*?

Alas the eye open, and still a vacant stare, breathing
warmly,

wound around (itself), slurping

17 [15]?

There is the black sad sea, like my destiny it lies before
me

– an open eye, but still craving sleep and still not looking
in
my direction.

Alas, the sea breathes with warm breath, like my destiny,
wound around itself on the pillow of its crags, and groans
in
evil anticipation.

I am sad for you, you dark monster, and for your sake I bear
a grudge against myself. Alas, that I do not possess enough
strength to deliver you from evil dreams!

– What are you doing, Zarathustra? Do you want to comfort
the sea with your song? Have you already become a compassionate
spectator of your own future?

Alas, you are a love-sick fool and excessively trusting!
even

toward everything that is terrible! (You) go to every monster

in order to pet it!

A breath of warm air, a bit of soft fur around the claws:
and

already seductive tones are pouring from your flute – truly
(you) are yearning for everything that is alive!

Better to trust your destiny, you blissful trusting man,
even

if it roars like a sea from a thousand maws – better still
its

teeth bared against you in a storm than such a pregnant
black
sullenness at night!

Your tenderness toward everything that lives is your danger,
oh Zarathustra! If you would have no creative will, watch
out!

All those who create must become hard hammers! Come to
me, you most terrible of smiths who forges even the hammer
itself into hardness.

490 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

17 [16]*4

Now everything is just great! For the hucksters are wearing
swords and walrus mustaches, and the regiment itself is the
place of the bowlegged."

Now everything is just great!

The best regents without principles, bringing joy to many
– and my best friends are among them

He felt no lust for crime, his taste was too healthy and
bright for such lusts.

But he also spared himself nothing and he committed
crimes against crime, for now he took the shortest paths.

And if a straight line is not a path at all, then the
shortest

path must be the crooked one

It is a shipwreck that first spits him toward his promised
lands

The greatest danger lies behind us – over there, where the
blessed isles are

I think little of prayer, I think more kindly of cursing:
and

now I call upon you to curse all cowardly devils who whimper
and fold their hands and want to pray.

the sea has gone mad – a snow-white mon(ster) has just
enough snow to drink its fill until mentally ill.

Now you speak to me of praying

Goats geese and other crusaders, led by the holy spirit?

you will be slit open, they believe that you have swallowed
gold

17 AUTUMN 1883 491

I am Zarathustra the Godless: who is more godless than I? "8
telling stories around the evening campfire (instead of the
doctrine)

to set crowns on our own heads

with a voice like a stonemason's chisel.

they creep around everywhere like lice

lust loves twilight: adventure shuns the day.

Pity those who would want to entertain others“? if this were no longer their livelihood!

They must fight with the wild animal, hunger, otherwise their entertainment would be that of a wild animal – aimed at us.

There are people with skills and people with jobs, there are those who can stand on their own – they have to stand up for themselves.

Thus do I praise myself for my part. Now it was your turn to praise me.

ill people and obsessed people queasy and querulous
you soon become accustomed to what is around you: and where you customarily sit becomes the seat of customs.
and with you I will always be like oil and water – floating on top, unless we get vigorously shaken up together.

492 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

servileand supine

You call them stilts – but they are pride’s strong feet
He rises and swells beyond all bounds: is it possible that his

fate soured him?

a contrarian is a bad spouse to himself

“by accident”? – this is not a good nobleman, even if he is of the oldest line?!

trumpeters and other butterflies

17 17]?

By all that is bright and strong and good
“wisdom is a creative labor pain” goodness

a means and a tool, like – – –

Next to every warehouse I saw an alehouse
that’s where they look for wine

And anyone who does not find warmth in spiced wine looks for it in spicy women.

A shipwreck spat him toward land.’

17 [18]°4 No “T” in Zarathustra 4!

17 [19]

Why are you blaspheming against yourself?

17 [20]*°

a puny community in the middle of nowhere, and their miserably clad mystification®®

17 AUTUMN 1883 493

Zarathustra) the Godless?°”

You are being pursued, a price has been put on your head
Keep it up, they can pursue us all they want: until now, success has always come to those who are most relentlessly pur(sued)°®

17 [21]"

Where is Zarathustra coming to us from? Who are father
and mother to him?® Destiny and laughter are Zarathustra's
f(ather) and mother: cruel destiny and loving laughter
spawned

a scion like that.

Cheerfulness as the secret foretaste of death.

"I am seeking Zarathustra. Zarathustra became lost to me.

17 22)"

the will to evil how it grows brighter and more beautiful
on the contrarians™ origin of virtue

Did I come to vilify vice and to warn against pickpockets?®

17 [23]

The sky is on fire and the sea spits at me"

17 [24]®

common and limited enough for the most limited advan-
tages, they still read the rubbish of their happiness like
tea

leaves.

They are rich: but their eyes are still thieves' eyes.

put good clothes on them – now they are rag-pickers and
vultures in disguise.

Curse – the brotherhood of hatred and lightning bolts

I went in search of origins – this alienated me from all
reverence: and all around me it became strange and lonely.

494 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

But finally reverence itself blossomed secretly again – and
behold! my tree of the future sprang forth for me –:

Now I sit in its shadow.

17 [25] °° relentlessly pursued, never caught!

putrid, tepid, rancid blood

you wanted to take the wildness out of humans, but you
have made them weak

you made wolves into dogs and humans themselves into the
finest human pets.

17 [26]

On Scribblers and Screamers 17 [27]

to bring unity into the greatest tension of a multitude of
oppositions – goal.

to condemn single drives as heretical and to kill them for
those who cannot bring them into a beautiful unity – infe-
rior moralities – their value.

the highest dialectic and its equal in every way, the
strength

of feeling.

what is most terrible: imperiousness and selfishness saints

17 [28]°

Chorus of fools "once we were sages"

0 17 [29]

a movement like a storm – and one goal and serenity at every place on the route

Zarathustra discovered that human beings had become inferior"?

17 AUTUMN 1883 495

evil people as destroyers worth honoring – destruction is necessary./?

Self-love and self-contempt – synthesis.

"Who among us is a seducer?" said Zarathustra and smiled – for amemory had come to him.

to cram the great noon full of resolved oppositions.'?

It is the age of puny people"

17 [30]

There are those who are actors without knowing it and those who are actors without wanting it.'

Some people will: but most are only willed."

To have a better sense of justice in my little finger" than they have in their heads."8

As long as selfishness is considered to be fundamentally evil,

you will never honestly be able to derive anything good from it

– and you have to honestly derive everything from it. For that

reason I have the organic-moral.'?

17 [31]®°

Zarathustra 4 at the end: fulfillments

Zarathustra 1 Preface: poor people (lowly, superfluous people) as rich people, the sages happy to feel ignorant and foolish

for a while (to become fools – festival of fools)

Choruses of poor people

of fools

Zarathustra 3, 1 premonition that terrible things will happen.

3, 2 the wanderer's deepest semblance of serenity

to collect the most painful things

496 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

17 [32]

to be burned at the stake, not for our faith, but for our doubt'®!

You ride quickly to your goal; but your lame foot will arrive

with you at the same time!®?

You say it is moral to do good for your neighbors? But then you would already have to know what is good for them!

17 53)" On servants a) rich people b) kings

Priests and merchants now rule.

17 [34]

There is a secret insight: great crimes are no longer needed – but rather many small ones.

in no way do I want "the happiness of others" – I much prefer their discomfort and despair under certain conditions

What! To tell the "truth"! I want to express my feelings and not to conceal myself.⁸⁴ Sp(encer) D(ata of) Eth(ics) p.

269.8°

Egoism not in contradiction with the heroic mode of thought!

Generosity, how you allow so many foreign and hostile thought processes to get power over you, you thinkers!

trapped in their tiny hearts®®

17 [35]*"

Deeply mistrustful of destiny, ready for sudden decisions, badly governed

17 AUTUMN 1883 497

Do I love human beings? Do I love myself? But they are a part of my plan, like me.

17 [36]*° Zarathustra 3 On Boredom.

17 [37]

I require a lot of altruism for the sake of my ego and its lust

to possess.

axoacial!®?

17 [38]°

This is the choice I have given myself: whatever / did not want before, this is what\ must want afterward (putting things

right, fitting things in – digesting – but checking to see if I

can do it!

17 [39]"

§ to make a poor person rich Emerson p. 383."

§ Bliss within the greatest expanse of the soul, longest lad-

der up and down

working redemptively against stuffy "sages."

The world – exuberance of a god"

Sin as enjoyment of self-abolishing.*

17 [40]"°

you are overlooking what a monstrous thing every organic

process already is, what a unity of opposites.
 To hurl ourselves again into opposites, after a drunken moment of reconciliation.
 the most expansive soul, which can err the furthest within itself%°
 the greatest sages, who hurl themselves into the ocean of foolishness
 the most necessary people, who hurl themselves into coincidences
 498 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS
 the one who is, who is becoming
 the one who has, who wants
 to approach each other again and again and to flee again and again
 the soul, for which everything is a game"
 17 [41]
 \$ (Zarathustra) 4 What is bad?
 \$ (Zarathustra) 4 the most superior soul, depiction of superhumans
 Do you not see how time is only an audacity and space an exuberance? And which mischief of freedom can be more mischievous than my rolling wheel of reasons and conclusions? they want no one to hurt them: that is why they come before him and please him – these cowards!"?
 17 [42]
 Epictetus as opposite 17 [43]'°° 11245 Reclus.
 17 [44]
 The one who warns: Zarathustra! Everything is ready to fall apart." Tell your people to save themselves and to give up their self-indulgent solitude.
 Zarathustra: Let my people be gathered and let heralds summon them to come to the great noon.
 17 [4s] Recipe for the mundane
 Do what you want, but take care not to offend with it,
 Do what you can, but take care not to be conspicuous about it.
 17 AUTUMN 1883 499
 17 [46]
 they want to learn how to play and have yet to learn how to be serious.¹⁰⁴
 It might be possible to fly – but first you have to know how to dance like an angel.
 No leaps in virtue! But a different path for every person!
 Yet
 the supreme path is not for everyone! Still, everyone can be a

bridge and a lesson for others!!

17 [47]

Perhaps it is not permissible to think about the meaning and value of art and artists as I do here, especially not now:

perhaps even less so to write about this the way I do – : per-

haps I have many things to atone for.

17 [48]

A small light, but even so, a great comfort

106 deep mistrust (of nature) needed

the breeding of strong humans.

Do what you want – assuming that you are the kind of people who can will and not be willed.!"

ove your neighbors as yourselves, assuming that you love

Love y1 hb y l that you |

yourselves!

109 17 [49]

The average person today is my greatest enemy – I owe it to Rée that I have gotten to know this person.

He had no ch(aracter): what could he do? So he had to steal one for himself.!!°

SOO UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

17 [sol

Not to believe in God.

Consequently things do not go as God wills. (Against the cowardly submissiveness that has made human beings weak: I teach a profound mistrust of this.)

17 [51]?

Zarathustra 3. He wonders: what has made human beings so puny, anyway?

Opposite of his friends

moral phrases as a theatrical means of enhancing ourselves.

his disgust grows ever greater

how pleased I (am) that I have my friends and that my thought /ives in them!

to fritter away

Happiness does not want to be sought, but rather to be found.

We should no longer seek what we have.

Anyone who has nothing to do is troubled by nothingness.

Whatever I want to do for you, you cannot do for me! And

whatever I do not want you to do for me, why should / not do this for you?

17 [52]

\$ against the dubiousness of justice

§ against clemency, as if we have to spare superfluous people!

"Alas, how necessary is everything that is superfluous!" you tell me

§ against weakness, induced by trust. I teach profound mistrust.!!4

§ against anxiety about shedding blood
in short: against all morality as weakening.

17 AUTUMN 1883 501

§ against religious communities à la Moravians!!> – Christians.

Concerning Zarathustra 4. You must first gain strength as destroyers!

17 [53] "6

they are getting weaker and weaker – ever since I stopped seeing them.

Mockery of my blessed isles, where some have fled– after a while it doesn't matter!

Concerning Zarathustra 4) It is high time to stir up the flame again.

It is now necessary to give up God: humankind would become too feeble otherwise.

17 [541

Defiance in selfabasement, going so far that he demands deadly revenge on witnesses
that's why God must die!

Even the animals are mew: thus I myself am willing it once again, anew.

Zarathustra 4. Widespread revolution – the sinking of the isles as omen.

17 [ss]

Zarathustra 3. The consolation of the saint outrages Zarathustra, he recognizes where weakness comes from.

Onward! Once again!

The saint: Do you want all this once again? and leaves.

After this, Zarathustra summons the most burdensome thought.

(Zarathustra) 3. Weakness your danger!

(Zarathustra) 3. A devil's grimace.

(Zarathustra) 3. Was the journey necessary?

Happiness is chasing after me: that's because I do not chase after women – and happiness is a woman.

502 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

17 [56]?

It is still too early for Zarathustra: up to now I was still my

own precursor

The superhumans emerge around the midpoint of the course.
the success of all things that are relentlessly pursued!?'°
My tombs opened: my pain which had been buried alive,
rose again – it had slept well under shrouds, in order now
to

get in a good night's watch.!!?

not to wade through foreign slime.!!??

(Zarathustra) 4 Supreme moment: one more time in the
name of all being!"

17 [57]

The thought that morality owes its origin to lawgivers and
that – – –

17 [58]!

Beware of willing anything halfway: be decisive in indo-
lence and in action. And whoever wants to be lightning must
be a cloud for a long time.!??

You must learn the long silence: and no one should see into
your depths. But not because your water is cloudy and your
face is unreadable, but rather because your depths are too
deep.

17 [59]'?'°

And anyone who woos the virtues of the strong should
forgo the virtues of the weak: and let there be no contempt
in
your renunciation.

How can you want to learn to dance when you have not
even learned to walk! And those who fly, and their bliss,
are

even above those who dance

17 AUTUMN 1883 503

Already I feel that I am dreaming: so perhaps I am almost
awake?

We should only steal when we cannot rob: thus speaks the
code of honor among rogues.

17 [60]!?'° Prescription 1) strengthen the will 2) no lasciviousness 3) learn silence 4) learn solitude

5) profound mistrust and profound trust!"

6) seek out your!" enemies, yet find your
friends.

17 [61]130

I do not want you to do anything "in order" or "because"
and "so that," but rather everything for its own sake and
for

the pleasure it gives you.

An end is what desecrates every thing and every deed: for

whatever must become the means is desecrated

17 [62]!3!

Plant yourself in the soil – as a new duty

Praise of chance, as it seeks out its friends

Doctrine of long-term willing in place of happiness

The old values annihilated

17 [63]?

So much goodness, so much weakness! It is not yet time to be benevolent.

§ On the community of cowards

Your stone is getting brittle!

to give the will a backbone

§ Our dignity as an eternal type

§ science teaches him nothing but its own fleetingness and transitoriness

504 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

17 [64]? My freedom's curiosity for novelty prisons.

134 took flight, even into

17 [65]

A curse on the fact that the best people secluded themselves without having children.

17 [66]'3°

Zarathustra 3 There is a hesitation within you: this created – – –

Modestly embracing a little happiness and, in that very moment, already modestly making eyes at another little happiness.

Watch out if you wanted to buy them, but offered too little, and thereby made their virtue stronger!

17 [67]

At noon, my happiness loomed hot above me (and) sucked thirstily from my ocean, I love strong winds and also know where they go and from where they roar. Soon I will become a strong storm

to implant our will so that it will become a long-term will and a tall tree with broad branches.

§ I do not want the virtues of the strong to be confused with

something else.!?8

17 [68]

Napoleon's speech – contempt for h(uman beings), he drives his nation to the heights and again awakens the thought that a

people may only live by finding faith in his supreme right. to make hard-hearted instead of meek

– long-term instead of fleeting – proud instead of modest

17 AUTUMN 1883 505

Conscience A chiseled arrow –

Do not speak to me of events! Nothing will ever happen to you except you yourselves!4°

17 [69]!

§ (Zarathustra) 4 the great contempt in the face of the eternity of the individual.

After that, redeeming: behold! I teach you about the super-humans

§ (Zarathustra) 3 none of them believe in their supreme right – peoples sages etc.

Conclusion of Zarathustra 3 “Arise abysmal thought! Now I am your equal!!*? “Make it hard as stone. You are my hammer!

–

Bliss of predetermined nature – hymn.

(Zarathustra) 3 Beginning. You have abandoned many things already –

Long eulogy with mockery at the end

All honor to those with a lust for power who took their contempt out on weak humans.”3

17 (ye

Anyone who up to now has had the most contempt for people – has this person in doing so not always been the people’s

greatest benefactor?

Take the child away – its gaze kills!

17 [71]”°

wrapped in a black cloud – do I bring you the plague? eternal satisfaction hurled itself into its opposite

17 [72]°

journalists as corpse robbers taking something from the half-

dead and the dead

Zarathustra 4 “let them come to me!”!47

506 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

“You bring good news: the swamp is moving”

If the most superior h(uman) being is not a ruler of the people-

ple, then the hucksters will rule.

Say it mornings and evenings: I despise hucksters, I want to break their fingers. Better more Handel than handlers!!”

against teachers who are not role models

Conclusion Behold, this is unchosen bliss)

17 [73]’”

A. Blanqui

l'éternité par les astres Paris 1872.150

17 [741°

the suffering of superior people on account of the imperfection of their inferiors

(the suffering) of God on account of h(uman)k(ind)

you have understood how to strangle ambition within

them: to be the last among you – this would give them more pleasure than to be the first

What makes superior humans suffer is not that which is inferior to them, but rather knowing that there is still some-

thing superior to them

17 [75]

Zarathustra 3. alone godless terrible terrifying, Zarathustra

should appear this way to the hermit –

the predatory /ion who finds delusion and arbitrariness in what is most holy

17 AUTUMN 1883 507

17 [76]

to make enemies, ever more intellectual ones – or everything becomes dull

Did I really come here to make human beings happy?

Whoever seeks pleasure will find little of it – even if seek-

ing it for others

Pleasure is a woman: she runs after anyone who spurns her.!??

17 [771

Zarathustra 3 Beginning. (Zarathustra) is satisfied – the seed

is well sown.

He has much in store for his disciples: first they must ripen.

17 [78]*

you figure out how to be happy and in the process you forget all future generations

Miscalculation in regard to happiness – we must want unhappiness.

to sacrifice the happiness of contemporaries for future generations.)

Ask women:!*¢ having a good time is not the point of giving birth.

17 [79]

There will be qualities having to do with our intellect that

pertain to it as an intellect, and other qualities that pertain to it

as a human intellect: this is now the point of actual conflict,

and we must not tire of sorting differentiating doubting and offering things to be learned

17 [80]!57

not to determine the value of things according to accompanying phenomena, e.g., letting labor pains dictate what birth

is about! Then it would certainly be bad!

508 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

"There is something that wants to command me. Why are we wrestling with each other, let's see who is stronger!" this is

g 8 how people become evil.

Alas for my melancholy! And even if I can still make it smile – angels should dissolve into tears when they see this smile. In the afternoon, when all light grows still.

Now no one who loves me remains alive; how could I still love life!

this thought! it only has to touch me with its fingertips and

I shiver and blush – and my heart beats until I feel it in my throat.

now I know it and I have grown happy and tired along with it – now "that's enough!" – According to you – yet / want to do what I told you to think

Artists

their hearts were courteous even in the face of frustrating coincidence – they took it as wisdom for hedgehogs, to raise their quills against destiny.

Here is something that commands – and not even a living soul with eyes and eyes of lightning, but rather – – –

When the hours slip away from us on tiptoes, in the afternoon, there where even all light grows more still –

The ocean lies there, long and spread out: and without shame in its blue nakedness?

And whenever I have no ladder, then I climb on top of my own head

17 AUTUMN 1883 509

Zarathustra, said the helmsman, I don't like this!

To depict what was heart-wrenching about my break with W(agner).

It got so still for me – there was no stillness before this:

(when) no one thinks of me and everyone speaks of me.
He is unshakeable: and when he complains, it is more a concession to you and it is a cloak that he throws over his hard-heartedness.

Alas, my yoke is heavy! the yoke of supreme obsession.
The only thing I have ever sought is my home, this hits home!*® with me the hardest.

17 [81]

It is a mistake to see altruism as a refinement of egoism.
This

would mean ranking it too highly.

The drives whose effect is most emphatically called selfish are the least selfish, e.g., the urges for food sex and wealth.

Here there is not yet any thought of a self but rather only of

the preservation of a specimen "human."

The control of these urges (or making them more difficult to satisfy!) is a consequence of the craving for self} of a feeling of self.

the common drives want above all and only to be satisfied at the cost of the other drives.

17 [82]?

– and the chimes of the bell are running in soft shoes –
And when the frost makes our souls crack and crunch, we rejoice: and we do not praise the land where butter and honey

– flow. !%0

510 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

A costly drop of sweet spicy wine hidden in a block of ice
– this is happiness to me – yes, if there were gods they would be envious of me on account of this drop!

And even when someone wants to lie down in our sunny spot, then we laugh, full of doubts, and we ask ourselves: are

we made in order to make others happy!

For us, happiness is the great exception and source of wonder: we fear it and we fear being in it, we gently push it away

from us, as a mistrustful lover would do.

17 [83]

tricky as doors that secretly open, so that the thieving wind

whooshes through

17 [84]

Look at this clear sky, will you! Has it not swallowed up
and
guzzled all of the stars – and yet it found its innocence
again.

My happiness once descended into a valley in order to find
lodging, my own sweet burning happiness, there I found these
pure souls open, like welcoming gates.

Alas, it rankles me and it worms around, my silly worm and
abyss of thought!

17 [85]"®'

Zarathustra, said the h(ermit), until now I took you for a
sage, but what amazes me about you above all else is that I
now see that you are clever as well. The worst lies behind
us

– yet you have escaped.

and looked at him sideways.

loutish virtues

17 AUTUMN 1883 511

17 [86]

Once I have overcome myself in regard to this, who then
will overcome me? And that is why this victory will be the
seal

of my perfection!

how could I dare to call you forth and look upon you!

17 [87]!

Only then, when Zarathustra has mastered his greatest
pain, will he fight for victory against his greatest dragon.

It was refugees and castaways who discovered new lands:

half-destroyed people have always been the conquerors.

Zarathustra, if we do not perish for your sake, we will make
our escape for your sake. But I have never seen things this
bad,

and nevertheless the worst now lies behind us.

Yet the helmsman who had been the last to hear Zarathus-
tra speak, uncovered his head and said reverently – – –

17 [88]

La gaya scienza'® is absolutely necessary for someone who
thinks as I do and wants something like this.

17 [89]

Honor and perfection to you oh Zarathustra!

[18 = N VI 7. Autumn 1883]

18 [1]!

If you can't pray, why can't you at least curse? Don't you
see

that we are fighting for our lives?

I fear you because you laugh while we fight for our lives:

you look like someone who is sure that you will live.
 Or die – said Zarathustra.
 And if we get out of this, I want to say “God is not? – and
 Zarathustra taught me this.”
 I forgive you your mistrust, yet I give you nothing in ex-
 change for your trust.
 I found in all things an arrogance that I called divine. And
 since I also found this arrogance in my soul, I also call my
 soul
 div(ine.)*
 You believe in wonders and wonderworkers; true need would
 also teach you how to pray. The old counterfeiters of the
 mind
 have also minted a counterfeit of your intellect.
 He lays his hand on millennia.
 18 pP
 On Tumult.
 4. Once, as Zarathustra was shipwrecked and spit out toward
 land and once, as he was riding a wave, he wondered: “where
 18 AUTUMN 1883 513
 has my destiny gone? I do not know where I should go from
 here. I am losing myself” He hurls himself into the tumult.
 Then, overcome by disgust, he looks for comfort in something
 – in himself®
 18 [3]
 the one who flies (as a discoverer who lays his hand on a
 millennium)
 18 [4]? 4. On Puny People. 5. Hucksters etc.
 18 [5]
 That the dice might fall the wrong way for us, is this a rea-
 son not to play dice? On the contrary – that’s where the
 spice
 58 is.
 18 [6]
 In painful agitation, Zarathustra tests violent people,
 fools,
 and those who fly, in order to determine if he finds himself
 in
 them – to no avail!
 Only after he learns of the death of friends
 He does not find himself in any human being – so he seeks
 out animals.
 § intensely mocking himself as advocate of life
 18 [7]
 I do not like sullen sneaks and salamanders. I can’t stand

will-o'-the-wisps either and everything that comes out of
the
swamp.

So is life a swamp?

514 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

18 [8]

A little song, but a great comfort for those who can sing
it:

and truly they must be good songbirds!

18 [9]

Suffering overflowed within him: this broke forth and poured
down toward a sea of patriarchs.

He called the sea of all patriarchs, God— for this, right-
eous

men called him a blasphem(er.)

18 [10]

Alas, my soul, how did you grow so hard-hearted toward
the one who had such superabundant love for you!

18 [11]

egomaniacal, selfobsessed, still not heard — and at the same
time a hero

18 [12]

Whenever gold clinks, there a whore winks. And there are
more whores than gold pieces. Whoever can be bought I call a
whore. And there are more who can be bought than there are
gold pieces.

18 [13]

I am best at despising life: and I love life most of all:
there is

no paradox in this — no contradiction.

Emotional torment

18 [14]

§ My head is foolish, but my heart is wise.

§ Everything leaves and passes away — everything comes
back.

— and leaving and passing away themselves come back

18 AUTUMN 1883 515

This now over there, has already been — it has already
been countless times

This doctrine has never been taught before. How's that? It
has been taught countless times already — Zarathustra has
taught it countless times.

18 [15]!°

Pain teaches hens and artists to cluck. Ask women: having a
good time is not the point of giving birth.

I saw wood piled up for someone to be burned at the stake:

brittle and pressed down, the woodpile waited for a spark:
 its
 own weight oppressed it
 He breathed out his desires to the boys: he rasped!! his
 words through dried-out gums, but the boys did not hear him
 We must scream at boys: violently rip open the door of their
 ears and eyes
 18 [16]
 In the dumbest world, there is indescribable enjoyment to
 be had even in a small bit of reason.
 Often I no longer know what I should ward off; I prefer to
 jump in and try things for myself.
 The power to transform things into myself, always growing.
 Assuming there were a God, the world could never be con-
 ceived as dumb enough for him.
 18 [17]
 to observe pain magnanimously – often the third genera-
 tion is the first one to deal with our pain i.e., a new
 power has
 grown within that generation.
 magnanimous in regard to people of the future – and this is
 the magnanimity of those who create, who love their work
 more than their today.
 satisfied people by far the most dangerous (satisfied with
 given ideals) especially the satisfied puny sullen people.
 516 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS
 18 [18]!2
 So have I come to vilify vice? And to warn against pick-
 pockets and shoplifters?
 Did I not come to teach them my riches and all my full-
 ness's excess yearning
 18 [19]"? On Princes. On Teachers. On Evil People. On Fame.
 Conversation with Lightning
 18 [20] On the Great Yearning. On Divine Desires" On Preg-
 nancy.
 18 [21]
 to force my enemies back behind their gate and to paint
 pale spots on the side of their gate
 The way through all 7 solitudes: in the end, the serpent
 18 [22]
 Did I not teach you about – the superhumans?
 18 [23]
 What do you know of sensuality! What could you know of
 sensuality!
 Sensuality is one thing, giving birth is another. Ask women:
 having (a) g(ood time) is not the point of giving birth.

Pain makes artists and hens cluck. Sensuality is silent –
hear now my words on fame.

18 AUTUMN 1883 517

thus she waits in the family way, !° radiant and satisfied,
the
pregnant one.

18 [24]!"

If you have your virtue in your ears, just see how well you
endure the noise of life. We are punished most often for our
virtues.

18 [25]

My destiny, defend me from all small victories! Preserve me
so that, just this once, my triumph – is as great as this
destiny.

I am speaking to you, providence of my soul, destiny
that I will be a surprise and never be anticipated, appear-
ing

like a ghost

that I do not grasp fear, but rather require the greatest dan-

ger in order to break free of the disgust that life pours
into me.

18 [26]

How many caves there are in life!

Being accustomed to caves, our yearning for them – a pas-
sage through dark tubes

18 [27]

You bolt of lightning, cutting diamond, gold zigzag! Answer
me, so that I can see whether you are cutting and sharp only
for the sake of appearance.

I often took you for a thinker – because, as with you, a
thought walks through clouds: and as with you, a thought
awakens the thunder that sleeps and rumbles behind the
clouds.

18 [28]

I learned to walk on a day that was awake: to walk lightly
on steady feet through a day that was awake.

518 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

While sleeping and dreaming – tell me, what did I learn
that put me in a good mood even while sleeping and
dreaming?

18 [29]

NB whenever I climbed up the mountain ridges
a herald for all brothers of the noon

18 [30]"? Sneaks, mousetraps

– For am la tricky money-huckster and a jingling purse?

Even in the good old days every day brought me a bad
 newspaper
 I have found this arrogance of wisdom in all things: that it
 tells all things to walk on the feet of fools.
 As little reason as possible: she does not take anything
 more
 in her knapsack, this arrogant wisdom when she tills her
 field
 during the day and walks across country.
 As little) r(eason) a(s) p(ossible) – this is, more delic-
 ately
 phrased: chance. All things run there and back on the feet
 of
 chance – – –
 Happiness and innocence are the most shameful things on
 earth: neither wants to be sought. We should have them –
 and we should not even know that we have them.
 their thoughts run counter to me: their meaning is a
 counter-
 meaning, their wit is a yes-but wit – but they do not stand
 and they do not walk – – –
 Everything speaks, everything betrays, and today's rasping
 ghost is already tomorrow's trumpeting at the marketplace
 18 AUTUMN 1883 519
 My foot is a cloven hoof: and I trot and totter with it over
 hill and dale, day and night, across and overland, and I am
 the
 devil's own, whenever lust makes me run fast
 My hand is a fool's hand: pity all tables and walls and any-
 where else that saves a place for fools' truths
 My mouthpiece belongs to the people: my speech is strange
 to all scribblers and ink-slingers
 18 [31]! On the Will to Suffer On Unchosen Bliss. Before
 Sunrise On Self-Diminution. The Wintersong On Passing By
 The Return Home of the Solitary One.
 The Other Dance Song.
 18 [32]
 Selfishness: a dirty and libelous word for the nature of
 everything living – that it wants to grow and to create be-
 yond itself
 that each and every thing walks around pregnant with its
 future – the lust of pregnant things and that, in its lust,
 it is
 often a miracle to itself
 18 [33]
 The powerful call their happiness virtue – their flowing

over-

flowing happiness, their gift-giving that rules.

18 [34]

Everything talks, everything is talked to death; and what today still seems too hard for the tooth of time will tomorrow

already be rent and ripped to pieces, hanging from a hundred maws.

520 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Everything talks, everything goes unheard; people might try to ring in their wisdom with bells, the hucksters at the marketplace drown them out with the clinking of pennies.

Everything talks, no one wants to listen. All water roars to the ocean, every creek hears only its own roar.

Everything talks, no one wants to understand. Everything falls into the water, yet nothing falls into deep wells.

Everything talks, everything sets things right. Injustice is pursued – relentlessly pursued but rarely captured.”!

Everything talks, no(thing) succeeds, everything clucks, but no one wants to lay eggs.

Oh my brothers! That you are not learning silence from me!

And solitude!

Everything talks, no one knows what to say. Everything runs, no one learns to walk anymore.

Everything talks, no one hears me sing: Oh that you did not learn stillness from me! And the suffering of solitude!

18 [35]?

The time of gods was at an end long ago: they laughed themselves – to death.

This happened when the most godless word of all went out from a god himself – the word:?? you shall have no other gods

before me: thus an old graybeard of a god forgot himself.

A god has never been so pathetic in his jealousy as to command: “you should have no other gods before me!”

And back then all gods laughed and wobbled on their chairs and cried out: “Is it not the nature of divinity that there are

gods but no God?”

You rogue-jester Zarathustra, how divinely you spoke to the last person who still believes in God!

18 [36]

And when I had done what was most difficult for me and was celebrating my triumphs of overcoming, blissful and exhausted,

18 AUTUMN 1883 521

then they screamed – they claimed I had stepped thought-
lessly on the toes of their vanity.

They all want to make themselves into a statute: and those
who can only climb, command: “thou shalt not fly.”

I am hard on myself: and I often take revenge for being
hard on myself by ignoring the injustice that others have
com-

mitted – their i(n)justice) against me!

And even if it is your guilt: I take it upon myself and call
it

my guilt.

18 [37]

And how could I talk you out of your willing, you with the
will of a lion! For I can read all of your willing in your
eyes.

18 [38]

I bless you, oh Zarathustra, just as if you, along with me,
belonged to one god and were a child of the same hope.

The way I see you – how could you want things to go
badly? Even if I do not understand what you say right away

This is, after all, what you are saying: and I will be
astounded

if you should ever persuade anyone with talk like this – un-
less

it would be corpses and buffoons

And I prefer to believe that you could win over animals
rather than people: especially your own animals! that ugly
serpent there and the roaring bird!

Thus spoke the hermit, for he was afraid of Zarathustra's
animals: and when the serpent stuck out its head just a
little,

behold, then the hermit jumped up and ran away.

Thus they parted from one another, laugh(ing) like 2 b(oys.)

18 [39]

This is my word that wanted to choke me!!

This is my serpent that crept into my craw

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18 [40]

What was most difficult for me, I learned to do in secret:
who had eyes for it, when I embarked alone into terrifying
new oceans?

And when I turned my back on all beloved idols, who saw
me go! Unseen I strode out into the burning deserts.

18 [41] The sealing”

18 [42]

And always, when I thought of my solitude, truly, it was

always as if I spoke from far away "oh precious solitude!"

18 [43]?

"Humans are something that must be overcome": to my ears this sounds like a laughing dancing piece of wisdom.

But

they think I am calling them – to crawl to the cross!

Certainly: before we learn how to dance, we must learn how to walk.

18 [44]

To live for the sake of the future §

the breaking of the tablets

18 [45]" "

Redemption! I spit out the serpent's head!

Redemption! I taught the will even how to will backwards

stillest hour Zarathustra you are ripe – lioness doves

Every time the midpoint when the wil/to the future emerges:

the greatest event awaits!

Prosperity and loving refreshment?'

Oh loving refreshment of my heart!

18 AUTUMN 1883 523

18 [46]?

Or did they fear my cursing? – for my curse is the brotherhood of hatred and of lightning bolts

They have made puny advantages puny – and now they are reading even the rubbish of good fortune like tea leaves!

Scarcely had fate soured them a bit – than they rose and swelled beyond all bounds.

These people in puny communities in the middle of nowhere, mist and conceit of all Bible-thumpers?

soft fleeting modest'!

18 [47]

That I have a decent handful of courage for living: this means,

I have a little key on me – which leads to nothingness.

That I have a decent handful of courage for nothingness – this means: I know that all nothingness – – –

The handful of force, my I – ridiculed by the universe of forces!

What I want? – to make courage into a small key for those who have failed

Courage for the few, to have their will prevail against the way-too-many

To compose and to create something higher than humans have been up to now

completely without responsibility, to embark into being, to teach bliss, which says: I want this one more time for (the

sake)

of this moment.

18 [48]? Ring of Rings

I whenever I dreamed of being the midpoint and noon of humankind.

II whenever I, like the alpenglow, brought back everything great from the past and made it shine.

524 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

III whenever I molded the future like wax.

IV whenever I broke the tablets and threw them down the mountain.

V whenever I went out – arrogance skepticism.

18 [49]

Humans are something that must be overcome: this is the doctrine of life as the great self-overcoming.?

18 [50]

I am a lawgiver, I write new things on my tablets: to the law-

givers themselves, I am law and tablet and herald's proclamation.

18 [51]

If I am the advocate of life – then I must also continue to be the non-advocate of its eternal change! –

A return of the greatest and the smallest things and of the entire ball and knot of reasons and conclusions.

18 [52]

My cleverness left me, this agile cat: my pride roared into the air! it seeks adventure for itself.

Now I sit here with my foolishness – the world quiet like a garden, the air tired from so many pleasant smells.

What welcome distress my foolishness causes me: it never wants to sit quietly and is always tumbling from the chair – will it ever grow tired of itself?

It does not grow tired even of its singing: but it learned the

tune from children, evenings when purple bliss hangs in the sky.

I forgive my foolishness, for it knows not what it sings: and

because I am so alone, I sing along with its nonsense – despairing at how often it falls from its chair in the process.

18 [53] On my walk I found

his long jackass ears –

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I also found my serpent,

which had lost its head."

8 [54]

you had saved all your purple and emerald bliss
Heat lightning of my happiness

18 [55]

Dühring – a p(erson) who scares people away from his way
of thinking because of who he is and who, like an eternally
yapping and viciously biting junkyard dog," lay down in sub-
mission before his philosophy.

18 [56]?

the humans who were overcome were themselves the fathers
of the superhumans.

Thus do I teach and do not grow weary of it: humans are
something that must be overcome: for behold, I know that
they can be overcome – I saw them, the superhumans.

18 [57]

"Do I have time to wait for my animals? If they are my ani-
mals, then they will know how to find me" Zarathustra's
silence

"you seek words of lasting peace in my place, the hermit's
place: the lasting peace of the deep world – alas, is this
last-

ing peace a hermit's heights?

And if the word of this peace goes through my ear and bone
and marrow, does it seek and, for this reason, still find
friends?"

Oh Zarathustra – the hermit replied – this is merely the
way you speak: I do not understand it: – and with this way
of

speaking you will have a better chance of persuading animals
than persuading people.?[®]

18 [58]

How much warmth do we know how to – withhold

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18 [59]?

One! Midnight commences – its song rises up out of the
deep world through ear and bone and marrow.

Two! Deep is all woe, but pleasure is deeper still and if
(it)

lays its hand on your breast – this goes through bone and
marrow.

18 [60]

So which suns would have set that once glowed for you on
the heights and on the innocence of your pinnacle!

18 [61]

Whatever a grapevine and a storm have in common, some-

thing unspeakable – in this even you should be a grapevine
and a storm.

18 [62]

almost starved by his expectations,
on dark paths over which hope flashes for me like heat
lightning

18 [63]

[19 = N VI 8 Autumn 1883]

19 [1]

Consolation 1) that there is so much that cannot be figured
out

2) that there is so much to make amends for.

advocating love for someone evil, someone who suffers.

ocean-paths to break! old tablets

19 [2]?

§ Do you still remember oh Zarathustra how you were in
the forest among p(eople) for the first time, how the birds
were

calling above you, how you felt the great abandonment

2) the great abandonment while among companions, when
you grew tired of giving gifts

3) the great abandonment by the stillest hour

Concerning the distinction from solitude

19 [3]°

The fabulists and dusk-dwellers and everything else that
flies,

crawls and limps on lame legs between evening and night.

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19 [4]

Pebble-chewers is what I call those who are all too satis-
fied

all too friendly:

Hog bellies – this is what I call these pebble-chewers

and they pray to everything as if to their God –

this is the taste of gluttons, the taste of those who stuff
themselves with everything –

19[5]

Oh my brothers, out of malice, for once I want to do things
the way puny hinterworlders do them: behold, I am drawing
the hinterworlders in the sand here! May someone come and
pick them out of the sand!"

Some kind of faith is already bringing bliss to some hinter-
worlders: onward, grab them when they're like this!

Oh my brothers. There are those among you who under-
stand how to laugh something into nothing – to laugh it out
of the room! And truly, laughter is a good way of killing!

I tell these kinds of people to follow my example: I came to them as their prelude.

And to those who have no peace at all, unless they finally see the world from behind, I advise:

should the world not be the exuberance of a god?

19 [6]

for in laughter all evil drives become holy: however, in such

a way that everything heavy becomes light –

19 [7]°

And every time the lion laughed, Zarathustra felt moved as never before, so that he felt around for his heart: for it always

seemed to him as if a stone had been lifted from his heart and

yet another stone and again another stone.

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19 [8]? Return Home. The Other Dance Song. Oaths. The Convalescent. The Old and New Tablets.

Hermits.

19 [9]®

You stir, you stretch? – You rasp.’ There is nothing new any-

more – you rasp – let me sleep!

This is it: there is nothing new anymore, this is what you are

yourself, abysmal thought: now you are awake!

19 [10]

You must also want to triumph; therefore it is not enough to be a fighter and a mercenary of life:

Thus do I whisper in the ear of Frisians and Saxons: to triumph you must also want to triumph!

Once life recruited you to be its mercenary – this is true: but now I advise you to recruit life to be your servant.

19 [11]

Whatever we lack but have a need for, this is what we should take: therefore, I took a clear conscience and made it

my own.

19 [12]’°

Tam in their midst like a diamond among lumps of kitchen coal: they do not believe me when I say: Oh my brothers! We are such close relatives!

19 [13]

Feeling good will toward the ocean and toward everything ocean-like, I feel the most good will just when they contra-

dict

me –

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19 [14]! On new Kings.

"Soon a storm will arise? – thus speaks my soul, the prophet,!? shaking: for the coming storms are already circulating within it.

(Cities and kingdoms and kings of the great contempt)

And the long dusk limps along in front of the storm, this sadness, tired and drunk with death, this sadness that speaks

with a yawning mouth. "Everything is the same, everything is empty, everything has been" – thus it yawns and drags its feet and is so tired that it can neither sleep nor die.

19 [15]

Or who is it that you love?

Organ grinders!

to bless i.e., to give a beautiful soul to chance.

choice: before and after

the shaping force against what is past

serenity of those who wait

courage of those who take risks

Pure i.e., without purpose.

19 [16] Forest animals On future songs to listen to your yearning

[20 = Z II 2. Autumn 1883]

20 [1]!

You go the way of greatness: now these are destined for you, abyss and – pinnacle in one.

Do not look around: let this be your greatest act of courage,

that no trail remains behind you.

Here no one shall creep after you: wherever your foot has trod, here the path has been obliterated and above it is written

"impossibility."

What previously was your greatest danger has now become your last refuge.

The time has passed when you were still allowed to be a wish: whatever you still are now, this should be hand and will

and grip of willing.

Some people will, but most are only willed.'

And you should bestow everything good upon yourself as someone who could also do without it.

There are those who are actors without knowing it, and those who are actors without wanting it.?

That we could bear our immortality – this would be supreme.

Have I gotten to the point where I teach puny people their puny virtues? They already know how to find them for themselves and they resent it terribly that I am not made envious by

what they find.⁴

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20 [2]

On the ocean.

Speech to his friends. I wanted to spare them, not to send them around as apostles, I became too loving toward them – now I have annihilated them by doing just this.

All in vain up to now!

Life, at midpoint, irretrievably sacrificed.

The most terrible thought of an eternal return of wastefulness.

Wasted humankind (and all fighting and greatness an eternally pointless game) (serpent and shepherd)

Unchosen bliss (the convalescent and pleasure in the superficial)

Seeing while in the great outdoors.

While demanding compassion, seeks his animals.

Clairvoyance concerning his wanting to give gifts. Wanderer, lightning.

Compassion for tyrants and for creators of peoples.

“I am trying it once again” solution. – Skepticism turned against all pessimism. – Forgetting, new beginning, as with all prophetic people.

Beyond Good and Evil (conclusion) prepared to do anything.

20 [3]° Draft for Zarathustra 3.

1. On the ocean. “Let the wind blow.” Columbus-like. Premonitions, driving forces, in what direction?

Irretrievably sacrificed. The wanderer. Late autumn.

2. A place to rest. The happiness of the free spirit. Not bound

even to his friends (you have set them free!) What does one person matter! The “wanderer.” Hesitate in your happiness!

Mood of “joyful science” and critique.

3. The burial rites and the speech to the friends. The most tender aspect of a solitary person.

4. Driven out, fleeing, despised. To summarize all the misery of the founders of religion, misery which comes from without.

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6. Clairvoyant about his "giving of gifts" and about his "love." – To feel like a golden lock and chain for many selves, this is his selfishness – this reveals the one who rules. – Goal: to personally portray the unity of the greatest multiplicity, the beauty of what is most ugly, the necessity of what is most coincidental. The state as means.

7. The only thing left for him is to tyrannize himself – with an unlimited will to suffer. Mockery of previous pessimists.
8. To summon up the most painful truth (possibility). What if you experienced this eternally again!

10. Mockery of those who trust life. Oh, that there were someone I could curse!

11. Beyond "good" and "evil" – the tartuffery" of the weak. Spencer 2 p 110°

12. Mockery of the artists: who relax in the pictures they create. – True meaning of fame: I want to be a spur and to score the flanks of all who come until they bleed.

13. Mockery of the enjoyment of those who know. "level-headed and ordinary"

14. Final escalation: wasted humankind. Compassion for those who rule and for their distress, and mockery of them.

16. He rips his serpent to pieces, the shepherd dies, he fights with his eagle.

20. The will: let us try it once again! Skepticism turned against pessimism.

21. The appearances: rainbow, lioness with flock of doves, the children's choirs.

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20 [4]

As long as action is called for, that is, commanded: synthesis

(the abolition? of the moral person) is not yet present. Not being

able to do otherwise: drives and commanding reason above and beyond purpose: enjoying themselves in action. Teichmüller p. 55.'°

the will itself is to be overcome – all feeling of freedom no

longer created out of the opposite of compulsion!

to become nature!

Error of Aristotle p 65"

for lust does not move us and the commanding reason does not move us.

the will does not move us, rather it is an accompanying phenomenon.

20 [5]

Against the Epicur(eans) – they freed themselves from an error and they are enjoying freedom as former prisoners do. Or

they have overcome, or believe they have overcome, an opponent that they envied, without pity for those who did not feel

themselves prisoners but rather felt themselves sheltered, still

without pity for the suffering of those who were overcome.

20 [6]

To evaluate the most inferior people according to their effect on “great people.”

1) the freeloaders – those who nest in the weaknesses of strong and great people

2) people in pain, who, like mosquitoes, inflict a lot of small

pain on great people and in this way diminish them – who also cloud up the clear sky with their yammering.

3) the well-meaning ones who do not know how to resist and who ruin the great people who are commanders: they make them into contemptuous people.

4) the comfortable ones: they make life trivial with their pleasure

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20 [7]

“The courageous person is the person who endures, fears or dares what should be done and why it should be done and how it should be done and when it should be done”!? Arist(otle) Liberator from the delusion “God” and even more from the delusion “God and humans.”

Determining what it means to dwell on the earth the eternal meaning of the individual. ego.

20 [8]?

Not complaining à la Hamlet! NB.

Plan for Zarathustra 3. 1 Zarathustra on the ocean.

2-10 Zarathustra hears of the death of the blessed isles.

Speeches against his true enemies.

The disturbing effect of his praise on his friends:

the city overthrown, Zarathustra has to tear

himself away: he despises their weakness in this.

terrifying outbreak of his contempt, and praise of

tyrants and of the most evil ones

11-12 Z(arathustra's) solitude. In vain! It is too late!

Death of the youth with the serpent. – Symbol.

13 Sick, appalled, Zarathustra seeks his cave. His animals flee and do not recognize him, the cave is utterly destroyed.

14-20 The hermit's speech. Zarathustra sees that trusting in God is the ultimate source of all weakening. One more time! Decision.

21-22 Summoning up the most terrible most abysmal thought. Predetermined nature – hymn.

Unchosen bliss (like a jealous man who pushes his beloved woman away from himself and who is still gentle in his hard-heartedness)

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20 [9] Zarathustra 3. Several speeches at the "grave" why did they have to depart from you?

In the end, compassion for all rulers and tyrants who took their contempt out on weak people (they exerted their own will

to the extreme)

none of them (peoples, sages, good people) believe any more that they are entitled to a superior humankind – I expose their

innermost doubts!

"I do not want the virtues of the strong to be confused with those of the weak."

Curse, so that the best people have to withdraw!

On the Reign of Cowards.

concerning the characteristics of friends'® (in the end, most stirring praise 1. strengthen the will no lasciviousness learn silence solitude profound mistrust and profound trust!"

seek out your enemies, yet find your friends.

Ane YP

20 [10]"® Zarathustra 4.

The king and the fool offer the notion that Zarathustra's coming is necessary.

Zarathustra draws ever smaller circles: great speeches in which he excludes. Ever smaller circles, on higher mountains.

First of all 1) the freeloaders are excluded, then 2) the hypo-

crites 3) the weak well-meaning people then 4) the unwitting hypocrites of morality.

Last scene: depiction of the supreme soul" that can reach

down the deepest, of the most expansive soul that can err
 the
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 furthest within itself, of the most necessary soul that
 hurls it-
 self into coincidences, of the soul that is, that falls in
 love with
 becoming; of the soul that has, which demands and wills; of
 the soul that flees from itself again and again and over-
 takes
 itself again: that is completely self-love and for that
 reason
 complete in everything: of the soul for whom everything is a
 game; wisdom that hurls itself into the ocean of foolish-
 ness:
 laughter and tears: the world, exuberance of a god: redemp-
 tion from all unique stuffy "sages" etc. – Sin itself as en-
 joy-
 ment of self-abolishing."°
 Allbeings merely preliminary exercises in unification incor-
 poration of opposites.
 Redemption from chance: what I have allowed to happen, I
 know I can make this up to myself afterward: and therefore
 wanting afterward what I did not want before.
 a goal all by itself
 After this, out of happiness for superhumans, Zarathustra
 relates
 the secret that everything returns.
 Effect. Pana wants to kill him.
 He finally grasps it, goes through all transformations, up
 to
 and including the most victorious, yet as he sees her lying
 there broken – he laughs. Climbs, laughing, up onto the
 cliff:
 but having arrived there he dies happy.
 Gripping effect of death: those who make vows.
 20 [11]?! Concerning the Single Victory.
 Just as I once saw him triumph and die: the friend who
 hurled divine moments and lightning bolts into my dark
 youth –
 playful and profound, storming forward toward joy while
 still in the storm of battle, bleeding more as he suffers,
 and
 where enemies were nearing the chosen flag, –
 the most cheerful one among the dying, the most decisive
 one among the victors, contemplating-anticipating as he

stands

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atop his destiny – exhilarated that he was victorious,
laugh-

ing that in dying he was victorious –

commanding through dying: – and he commanded annihilation and no mercy –

Oh you my will, my In-Myself, Above-myself! you my necessity! Make it so that I triumph in this way – and spare me for

this one victory!

Preserve me and spare me and protect me from all puny victories, you destiny of my soul and cusp of all need, you my

necessity!??

20 [12]?

Don' I know, like you, all cheerfulness – even the cheerfulness in the anticipation of near-death: for the great burden

that I bore, let me often rejoice in times of great danger puny community in the middle of nowhere and mist and conceit of all Bible-thumpers – they all need rooms and little

chambers for their praying!

Like me, you are “by accident” this is the oldest nobility in

the world.”⁴

and not to their promised land do I wish to follow the spirit

that they call holy: I have always seen goats and geese among

its leading crusaders

intimate and welcoming, but like gates through which only lowly things pass.”

20 [13]

The solemn toy trumpeters,”” who with their melodies preach dreary doctrines and lies.

I wish I could already see the pillar of fire in which they are

being burned: for such pillars of fire must precede the great noon.

How many caves does life have

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Before Sunrise.

20 [14]

I have found in all things an arrogance I call divine. I

have
 found this arrogance even in my soul.
 I have found this arrogance of wisdom in all things, that
 this wisdom tells all things to walk on the feet of fools.
 As little reason as possible: this wisdom does not take more
 than that in its knapsack when it walks overland and tills
 its
 field in the daytime.
 All things run on the feet of chance – to there and back
 and upward to wisdom,
 – this is its blissful safety, that it lures all things to
 itself
 only by using chance.
 20 [15]""
 Preferring most of all to be nourished by innocent things
 and impatient and ready to fly away from those few things:
 why shouldn't something about me be bird-like?
 The spirit of gravity, arch enemy even to the body as well:
 where did my enmity not follow it! Where has my winged
 mortal hatred not flown and not gone astray!
 20 [16]? Prophet Annihilator One who creates Unifier Ex-
 plorer (ocean) Dancer – Laughing one
 One who flies – One who triumphs
 [21 = Mp XV 3b. Autumn 1883]
 21 [i]! (Concerning 3.)
 Summoning up the weightiest truth.
 Song of mockery of all previous pessimists.
 Song of mockery of religions and their attempts to flee.
 Song of mockery of socialists Jesuits and Epicureans.
 Song of mockery of artists up to now.
 Compassion and honor to all great lawgivers, field marshals
 and conquerors.
 What friends!
 Overcoming nature by means of great humans.
 Song of the one who flies.
 The sick person's song of comfort – Tired: growing still.
 Will to suffer.
 "Tam fatum"
 "beyond morality," above and beyond all praise.
 skepticism as temptation?
 suicide as temptation
 Hymn of the convalescent.
 To conquer for ourselves the country that we deserve, no
 matter in whose hands the country wants to be
 21 [2]° Plan for Zarathustra 3.
 Solitude in shame and silence when facing the greatest

thought.

Avoiding the animals

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(Solitude) of a single will that conceals itself from everyone,

but that raises everyone up

Solitude

without friends, indeed with the feeling of having sacrificed

them.

Solitude bereft of all reasons to feel comforted, song of mockery

of all previous forms of pessimism (well beyond all previous modes of thought).

Solitude and temptations. Song of mockery of previous attempts

by religion to flee

Solitude of supreme responsibility. Song of mockery of socialists

and Jesuits and Epicureans.

Solitude beyond morality, in eternal perspectives. Overcoming

of great nature through humans. Song of the one who flies.

Solitude of the sick person. Song of comfort. Becoming tired and quiet. Sanctified through suffering. The will to suffer and to intensify the suffering.

"I will this!" Hymn of the convalescent and of the victorious

one. The laughing lion and the swarm of doves. (A temptation – nothing more! he himself and his thought) The 4 animals arrive (pride with cleverness – power with gentleness) – they approach each other

21 [3] Plan for Zarathustra 4. 1. The invitation.

2. The victory parade. The plague city. The stake (the old culture was burned).

3. The spring festival with choruses.

4. Being called to account before Zarathustra: "what have you done?" (what have you invented?)

Kind of community (as in Corsica).

. Places of residence. . Wars and wrestling matches. . the new nobility.

. the temptations (with evil people, "punishments" etc.)

ON AM

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II.

I.

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to redeem the woman in women'

slaves (beehives) learn to bear serenity. More machines.

Reshaping the machine into the beautiful

time for solitude. Division of the day.

long youth and the transformations.

After that, Zarathustra's great speeches, similar to prayers.

13.

21.

a few unusual saints arrive, who are also disciples: also a fool (Epicurus?)

The sanctification of laughter. Future of dance. Victory over the spirit of gravity.

. The innocence of becoming.

. The consecration of the smallest.

. The breaking of the tablets. Praise of cool reason!

. The redemption of evil people and the redemption from moral judges!

. Summoning the enemy.

. The new kings – as model teachers.

. The eternal "I" and its sanctification. Determinism and its solution. There is no morality and no absolute responsibility, we determine them for ourselves

beatification of drives

Decisive moment: Zarathustra asks all the masses at the festival: "do you want all of this once again?" – everyone says "Yes!"

He dies of happiness as this happens.

(the sky clear, low) (ominous, clear, eerie)

(deepest silence, the animals around Zarathustra, he has covered his head, arms spread on the stone slab – appears to be sleeping) the howling dog

something luminous terrible quiet moves above and away from all of their thoughts

The speeches by those who make vows, around his corpse, constitute the conclusion.

Those who make vows.

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22. etc. The great noon as turning point – the two paths.

The hammer for overpowering humans: supreme development of the individual, so that it must perish on account of itself (and not, as has been the case so far, on account of dietary mistakes!) (how death came into the world!)

What happiness!

The one who creates as the self-annihilator. Someone who is a creator out of goodness and wisdom. All previous morality surpassed!

In the end the vows – terrible oaths!

ar [4]

Chorus of the godless (overcoming the churches)

Chorus of the honest (overcoming moral tartuffery)

Chorus of the penitents of the mind (overcoming idealistic vanity)

The order? of the hard-hearted (overcoming compassion)

The rogue-fools.

1. New order of rank of humans and new distribution of rights.

Visitors at Zarathustra's place he is asked for help

1) universal slave-revolt 2) softening of hearts, weakness

3) darkening and insanity

the happiness of the community (but solitary people enjoy it!)

the happiness of truthful people (as opposed to all the effort of

playing hide and seek). The omens.

the burning of the large city.

21 [5]

Finite as space: infinite as time.

with indestructibility, eternity is given and beginninglessness

by being determined, a limit to the multiplicity of new forms.

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21 [6]°

Humans are that which must be overcome. Here I hold the hammer that will overcome them!"

This viewpoint brings bliss to Zarathustra at the conclusion of Part III

he becomes ripe in the process.

the previous evasions and attempts to flee in the face of the

greatest thought:

Nirvana, the thought of nothingness brings bliss.

the wonderful re-creation in the beyond and then eternal life

(in Christianity)

bestialization, as bien public? – consequence of Eudaimonists

socialists Jesuits.

absolute skepticism about our minds and practical letting

our-

selves go. "What do I know about actions!"

Determinism: I myself am fate and I have conditioned existence

for all eternity.

Many drives fight within me for supremacy.

in this I am a replica of everything that lives and I can explain it to myself.

Suddenly the terrible chamber of truth opens. There is an unconscious reaction of self-defense, caution, concealment, protection from the weightiest knowledge: this is how I have lived up to now. I kept something secret from myself; but the

restless pronouncements and rolling away of stones turned my drive into something overpowering. Now I roll the last stone:

the most terrible truth stands before me.

I. Summoning truth up from the grave.

We created it, we awakened it: highest expression of courage and of the feeling of power.

Mockery of all previous pessimism!

We wrestle with it – we discover that our only way to bear it

is to create a being that bears it: unless we would freely
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choose to blind ourselves again and make ourselves blind to it. But we are no longer capable of this!

to bite off the head of the serpent!

We created the weightiest thought – now let us create the being for whom the thought is light and blissful!

In order to create, we must give ourselves greater freedom than

has ever been given to us; in addition, liberation from morality and relief by means of festivals (intimations of the

future! to celebrate the future, not the past! To compose the

myth of the future! To live in hope!) Blissful moments! And then to draw the curtain again and to turn our thoughts to concrete immediate goals!

[22 = Z II 3a. End 1883]

22 [1]!

Alone with myself and with my rejoicing conscience

You had your friends together on a tiny island and your enemies among them: how sweet it is to love and to hate!

Doesn't the father still have to resist the son even in what

he

does best? And anyone who has ever claimed a right for himself will not give this right even to his own son, out of love."

We are punished most severely for our virtues. And thus learn to guess where your virtue lies: there, where you have been most severely punished.?

Lonely days want to walk on courageous feet.'

I have become clairvoyant: a diamond sword cuts every darkness to pieces for me.'

The reflection of their happiness flew over me like a shadow:

and when they felt strong and sure-footed, mistrust crept toward

me and its sibling, weakness.

We should redeem the woman in women!® And let women lust for men but not for what is manly!

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Still no one has time for me. But what is the deal with a time that has no time for Zarathustra!"

I am told that humans love themselves? Is this true? I have still found humans to be the predator of all predators, even against themselves.°

"What Zarathustra has decided, this will happen: how should his great soul be capable of changing its resolve!?" Take pity on your foot so that it doesn't step into a morass:

and that's why you should not even bother kicking those who have betrayed their friends.!°

I recognize people who are super rich by this: they thank those who take from them."

For me there are no true orators and super-orators unless they

can convince the arguments themselves to run after them.!?

You are riding quickly enough to your goal; but your lame foot is mounted alongside you and will arrive with you at the

same time.!?

This is my fear on your behalf: that you will stumble just when you are at your pinnacle!

There are those who are actors without knowing it and those who are actors without wanting it.'

Some will, but most are only willed.

The time has passed when you still were allowed to have wishes.!®

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Puny virtues are necessary for puny people: but who can convince me to believe that puny people are necessary!"

You aren't envious of their virtues – they will never forgive you for that!

You go the way of greatness: now these are destined for you, abyss and pinnacle in one.

Stop looking around: let this be your greatest act of courage, that behind you no path remains.

Here no one should creep after you: wherever your foot has trod, there the path is obliterated and above it is written: impossibility.

What previously was called your final danger has now become your last refuge.!!®

This is his folly: he cannot endure all those who give warning or the voices of birds – he flees into his abyss because he has been warned about it.

"Chance" is what the weak call it. But I say to you: what could befall me that my gravity would not compel and draw to itself?

Look, will you, how I first stew each coincidence! in my juices: and when it is done, it means, for me, "my will and destiny."

Whatever it is about my chance that seems foreign to my body and will, how could I offer hospitality to that! Look, will you, only friends approach friends.

Warning birds flew up out of my happiness itself.

Experience came imperiously: but my will spoke to it – already it was on its knees, pleading."°

Do you want to be a stumbling block for those who stride ahead? Do you want to limp along in front of whoever is in a hurry???

22 END 1883 549

Those who look backward and go forward deserve to be run into: lest they punish their eyes with their lying feet.*

"It is showing itself" you complacent ones say: but complacency always withdraws and will keep withdrawing more and more.

23 more.

Even what we have left undone weaves the fabric of the entire future: even our nothingness is a master weaver and a woman spinning webs."4

Many have grown weary of themselves: and only then does the happiness that was reserved for them catch up with them – but they have always been running on too rapid feet!"

My drink should still make you sneeze: my sparkling wines
should tickle your noses and fill you with lust.?°

Ask my foot whether I find your manner pleasing: dancers
have their ears in their toes, do they not.?7

I have reached the end of my humanity: I, the gentlest person,
have become the most hard-hearted –

Did I ever fall asleep on my fame? Every kind of fame has
been like a bed of thorns to me.”8

Am I not the meteorological divide? Don’t all winds come
to me and proclaim their will to me?”

And the ice and innocence of my peaks are also still
aglow.*°

I still am like a cock in a strange barnyard, pecked at even
by hens.?!

There is more injustice in your admiration than in your
contempt”

550 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Do as I do: only doers learn; and only as a doer do I want
to

be your teacher.??

That a bolt of lightning would strike your feed! That your
maws would finally learn to feed on fire!*4

You crash up against me like waves: – but I strike your
heads with my oar. Behold, you bear my boat into
immortality!’

Here stands my will: the surge of my pride still founders on
ir.

I want to make wildfires of you and heralds with tongues of
fire: but until now you were only arid grass and steppe.?”

Gold flashes in his dark eyes: a golden bark floats there,
on

black waters.38

Actors have no time to wait for justice: and often I have
looked at impatient people to see whether they were not
actors.

They all want to exist – and they call this justice. And “to
make things equal” –

– to spare too much – some people are like this: to yield
too much – other people are like that.

We should only steal when we cannot rob: thus speaks the
voice of honor among rogues

Already I feel that I’m dreaming: so perhaps I am almost
awake?

How can you want to learn to dance when you have not yet
learned to walk? Yet those who fly, and the bliss of above
and

below, are even above those who dance.

22 END 1883 551

And anyone who woos the virtues of the strong does not have to glance lustfully at the virtues of the weak, but rather

should pass by these pretty maids without taking notice.>*"°

Alas, it's too bad that you believe you have to despise what you have merely renounced!

One day I noticed that I had lost my patience: so I went out looking for it – and I looked high and low. But you probably think, my friends, that I found it again? Quite the contrary:

yet I discovered so much in the course of my journey that I have to tell you about it – and I swear to you, just as we are

setting forth for the first time, that you will lose your patience

during the telling. – And don't think that I would have it any

other way: for the best of everything that I have learned and

discovered since then is just this: "it is time for many people to

lose their patience."

And above all, for you, my friends!

Beware of willing anything halfway: and be as decisive in indolence as you are in action."!

And whoever wants to throw lightning bolts must float in the sky as a cloud for a long time.*?

You must learn the long silence; and no one should see into your depths.*?

And those who excel at silence are not the ones who veil their faces and cloud their waters, making them impossible to

see through.

Instead, it is the bright, the brave, the transparent ones who

excel at silence, whose depths are so deep that they cannot be

revealed even through the clearest water.

For it is through these that silence reveals itself not to be

silent.

552 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

It is still too early for me: up to now I have only been my own precursor and herald's proclamation.

You should not wade through foreign slime: rather, here
your talent lies in running fleetingly across it like a look
of
divine contempt.

All things that are pursued relentlessly have been success-
ful

up to now."4

My tombs opened: my pain which had been buried alive
rose again.— it had concealed itself under shrouds in order
to
get a really good night's sleep, — have pity on me, in order
to
get in a really good night's watch!"

My happiness is chasing after me, said Zarathustra — that's
because I do not chase after women: and happiness is a wo-
man.*°

And humans abased themselves to such a degree before
God, and they carried their self-defiance so far, that now
they
seek deadly revenge: and so, he who saw everything had to
die!

Revenge on witnesses — —"

This is shame's scam: it wants to believe it is only giving
way

to violence; and what it would like most of all is just to*®
yield

and to wallow in the despair of weakness.

Anyone who has nothing to do is troubled by nothingness."

Whatever I do not want you to do for me, why should Z not
be allowed to do it for you? And, truly, that which I must
do

for you, precisely this you cannot do for me}?

They all have no character: what could they do! they had to
steal one for themselves."!

22 END 1883 553

Do what you want anyway: but first be those who can will
something!

Love your neighbors as yourselves anyway: but first be those
who love themselves"

A small light, but even so a great comfort for the voyager
whom the night wants to betray to the wild ocean."?

To forget: this is a divine skill. And those who want to
rise

into the heights, and to fly, must throw much that is heavy
into the depths and make themselves light — that's what I
call

a divine lightness-skill.>4

At a distance, we think poorly of someone else. But two people together – how could they not wish each other well! Solitude ripens: it does not sow seeds.

Watch out if you wanted to buy some people but you offered too little, and now you have made their virtue stronger because

it has already said no once.

Modestly embracing a little happiness and, in that very moment,

already modestly making eyes at a new little happiness –

My freedom, and its curiosity for novelty, took flight, even into prisons.?°

I see so much goodness, so much weakness: and you treat each other properly and deftly, like grains of sand.

An end is what desecrates every thing and every deed: for what is holiness, if it does not lie in the heart and conscience

of the thing and deed!

554 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

I do not want you to do anything “in order” and “because” and “so that,” – but rather everything for its own sake and for the pleasure it gives you.”

And if up to now someone has had complete contempt for people – has that person in doing so not always been the people’s greatest benefactor?°®

“What does this dark cloud of a person want? Does he want to bring us the plague!”

“Take the children away: eyes like that scorch young souls.”*?

You speak falsely of events and coincidences! Nothing will ever happen to you except you yourselves! And what you call coincidence – you yourselves are your own incidents and accidents!

At noon, my happiness loomed hot above me, my sun drank thirstily from the ocean – now a night of clouds comes along and sudden winds.

I know well where winds come from and where they roar

61 off to

to implant his will so that it becomes a tall tree and still brings shade to future generations – a long-term will!®?

What is this that you call your conscience, anyway? Not a law, but rather the fact that you need a law and an arm to hold

you steady, you drunken stumbling people!

“soft, fleeting, modest”®

should I stand there and whine about that whore, happiness? Or about "Stepmother Nature"?

22 END 1883 555

You are building a fence around yourself with praise and blame.

And when you cannot endure life, you must attempt to win its favor – for such has always been the artful strategy of the

greatest sages.

Their most artful, boldest strategy was to believe in God whenever they felt that the devil was too near.

They learned to switch names for things: and so things became switched around in their minds. Behold, this is the artfulness of the greatest sages in its entirety!

Most people are too crazy to be self-interested: their happiness makes all of them crazy.

They sacrifice everything for one thing – this is a kind of love. This willfulness and self-absorption loom over all people.

Their intense insanity bubbles forth for them, out of their love: but it is a poor calculator and despises the cold virtues of

the huckster.

For huckster-virtue, the huckster's money-grubbing fingers and lusting eye – this is even beneath the dignity of an animal.

Everything that can be bought is worth little: I spit this doctrine into the faces of hucksters.

Money passes through all fingers: therefore learn to handle money and moneychangers with kid gloves.

Praise be to puny poverty: for all hucksters scheme after great wealth.

Wherever coins ring, whores rule.

Those who have always spared themselves a lot will finally get sick from sparing themselves too much.

556 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

He speaks roughly but not from a rough throat: every gust of wind makes him speak more hoarsely, this sensitive little thing!"

And we often teach despairing people to be strong only by speaking to them about their weakness.

Some are gluttons, others nibblers – both contemptible.

Begetters and breeders.

Oh these narrow huckster-souls! Whenever money jumps into the money box, the hucksters' souls jump in along with

it.

Whose souls have been a money belt and whose happiness has been dirty pieces of paper – how could their blood ever become clean?

It will flow lifeless and foul smelling unto the tenth generation-

tion:© the descendants of the hucksters are indecent.

On scribblers and screamers.'° On substitute teachers."

Get away from me, my tempter, Zarathustra said to the old man and kissed his trembling hand; he smiled at his own words, for a memory had come to him."

It is the age of puny people."

To have a better sense of justice in my little finger" than those people have in their heads.

Chorus of fools i.e., of sages who briefly feel themselves to be

ignorant und foolish"

Chorus of the impoverished i.e., of narrow-minded superfluous

people whose yoke is light. – Emerson p. 283.

22 END 1883 557

To be burned at the stake, not for our" faith, but rather for

doubting our faith –

I no longer want to conceal what I feel: why are you talking to me about truth!"

His mind is trapped in the cage of his tiny heart."®

Do I love human beings after all? But they are a part of my plan – yet this is the extent of my love."?

Mistrustful and full of ulcers, capable of sudden willfulness, determined guard and lurker

Whatever I did not want before, this is what I must want afterward – no other choice has been given to me.®"

Opposed to the stuffy sages, redeeming from them – the soul, to which everything becomes a game.*!

They want no one to hurt them: that is why they beat all people to the punch and please them – these cowards!??

"Do what you want, but take care not to be conspicuous about it! Do what you can, but take care not to offend with it!"

Recipe for the mundane.

There are no leaps in virtue.®4

seek out your enemies, find your friends®°

Prescription: to will for a long time, no lasciviousness, learn

silence, learn solitude, learn profound mistrust?®

the stone is getting brittle®"

558 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

to give the will a backbone – by means of an organization®
A curse on the fact that the best people are secluding themselves without having children.®?

To the murderer of God, the seducer of the best people, the friend of evil people"

Anyone who up to now has had the most contempt for people, has this person in doing so not been the people's greatest benefactor?!

– Corpse robbers who know how to steal something even from the pockets of the dead and half-dead
Better more Handel than handlers!

Say it mornings and evenings: "I despise hucksters, I want to break their sticky fingers."

What makes superior humans suffer is not that which is inferior to them, but rather knowing that: "there is still some-thing superior to me." Propelled into the heights, like a ball

– this is what they call "climbing."

You have strangled their ambition! To be the last among you would give them more pleasure than to be the first!"
"Pleasure is a woman: she runs after anyone who spurns her."

You are figuring out how all people could be happy and in the process you have forgotten future generations – the happiness of most people!"

Just ask women! Having a good time is not the point of giving birth.?⁷

22 END 1883 559

"It wants to command me? Come on, let's wrestle with each other: perhaps my will is stronger!" – concerning the emergence of evil people.

Now no one I love remains alive: how can I still love life! Angels dissolve into tears when they see him smile
Tired and happy, like everyone who creates, on the seventh day.

My heart was courteous even in the face of frustrating coincidences: to raise my quills against destiny seemed to me like

wisdom for hedgehogs.

Already the hours run on tiptoes across our hearts.

And whenever I had no ladder, I always climbed on top of my own head.

There was no stillness before this: no one thinks of me and everyone speaks of me.

I sought myself and a place where I might be at home – this hit home with me the hardest.”®

I sought my heaviest yoke: that’s where I found my selfishness.

He is unshakeable, and when he complains, then it is more a concession to you and a cloak that he spreads over his hard-heartedness.??

I do not praise the land where butter and honey – flow.!°°
“The worst lies behind us”)?!)

“I thought you were a sage – but what astounds me about you more than anything else is your cleverness.!”?

560 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

loutish virtues!”

“I want to live the way I wish or I have no wish to live” – this is how the most saintly people still think.1%

Where I always felt fear, I will finally make a wish – oh abysmal thought, now I am still learning to love the abyss!!
Selfishness and imperiousness have brought lies to an absolute pinnacle.

You are look(ing) at the rock of the highest mountains, aren’t

you? Did it not form under the oceans?

Beware, you who are the wealthiest: puny acts of charity spark more outrage about you than extreme miserliness. You drip like wide-bottomed bottles with all-too-narrow necks – bottles like these have already had their necks broken many times.!06

These neighbors and their puny distress, this city and its meager air – this chips away at your strength every day. How could you want to learn how to cause great pain in this place!7

Clumsy as a corpse!®®

“Let us be modest in virtue as well! Only modest virtue can get along with comfort” –

Scribblers and screamers, those panting with ambition, pushy and shameless people –!”

For does a drive want to be “satisfied,” as you teach? Does it

want to be free of itself and have peace? Has a will ever willed

not to will?

22 END 1883 561

What drives all drives is that they create: and if they sleep

for a while, then they are only sleeping in, in order later to

become – fully awake.

We have to sleep in, so as to become fully awake.

But you have distorted the essence of willing into unwilling and willing against itself; you have always misinterpreted the

voice of the tired will and the snuffling and snoring of the sleeping one.!!°

For is sleep an invention in response to death? And would whoever wants to sleep be someone who is weary of dying?

Even the liveliest person can snuffle and snore.!!!

Equal rights for all – this is the most extraordinary injustice: for then the most superior humans lose out.!!?

Equality was always praised most highly: it wins the praise of most people – of those people who were not allowed to have

equal rights!

He broods on his misfortune like a hen on an egg.

Oh you who know, you, too, are intrusive! And this is to be your reward, that you always see the foreground of all things!!"?

His mind is failing – now the good and the bad in him grow more visible: he grows darker – alas, if it were only new

stars that now grow more visible!

22 [2]!14 Plan for Zarathustra 3.

At the ocean (late at night)

On unchosen bliss. On the virtue that diminishes.

On the stake.

562 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Zarathustra's self-knowledge (as a betrayal of friends) Now the disaster begins. Story. Zarathustra's defense: 1) on lawgivers and princes 2) on hucksters 3) on substitute teachers 4) on pious people the great curse Story.

The fool's comfort – on science – everything the same, equal, etc.

Zarathustra seeks the last thing that loves him: in vain.

Conversation with lightning. Eternally "In vain!"

The boy and the serpent Zarathustra sick. The saint Z(arathustra's) answer for the saint. The decision.

Praise of predetermined nature as farum.!!

The way of the convalescent.

5

116 22 [3]

It is treasonous to strive for greatness: whoever has it,

strives

for goodness.!!”

The deepest love does not know what to call itself and is prob-

ably asking itself, “Am I not hatred?” – If we once – – –18

Do we not do the same thing awake as we do in our dreams?

We always first invent and poetically imagine the people we associate with – and in the next instant we have already for-

gotten this.!!?

When will man and woman stop misunderstanding each

other? Their passions walk with different strides, – they mea-

sure time according to different measures.!”°

22 END 1883 563

In order to see far away, we need to learn to see beyond ourselves.!!?

And those who believe in their life after death surely have also learned to be dead in life.!!?

People of faith!?? do not hate freethinkers the most, but rather new thinkers that have a new faith.

Ponderous, melancholic people become more lighthearted

through hate and love: here they rise to their surface.!*4

The matter is clarified: now it does not concern us anymore.

Beware of becoming too enlightened about yourself!

Compassion for the entire race – this leads to hard-heart-
edness against every individual.!”

Terrible experiences seek out terrible people.

I, too, am the ore with an iron destiny: this is how I felt whenever you mentioned destiny.

He has his own god for himself: but ever since I saw that god, I have seen in him only the ape!” of his god.

There is a degree of inherent mendacity that we call “good conscience.”

They chase after anyone who convinces them that they have lost their way. It flatters them to hear that they had a way at

all.!?7

The great thoughts that come from the heart and the petty ones that come from the head – both are badly conceived.!”8

564 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

You want to be judged by your intentions and not by your effect? But where do you get your intentions anyway? From your effect!!”?

Those who haven’t known how to find the way to their goal live more brazenly and more frivolously than those who have

no goal: they want to laugh it off and get over their loss.!

°°
The danger for sages is to become infatuated with foolish-
ness.

They sacrifice themselves, not out of compassion, but rather out of abundance: they reward others, they reward them with themselves'?

The devil, a friend of knowledge, stays away from God: only from far away is it possible to develop an eye for gods.!*
Love brings what is superior and unusual in someone to light: this is how it beautifies – through deception about someone (most of all self-deception!) But pay attention to what happens when people are aware of being loved but do not love back: there the soul itself reveals its sediments.!*4
Not only the herd, but also the shepherd, has need of a bellwether.!

Why so apart? – I find no one else I could obey and no one I would even like to command.!?®

An elephant that tries to stand on its head.!?7

You think everything has been accomplished when you have rendered lightning harmless? But / want it to work for me. – This is how I think of all the evil in you and in me.!

®

22 END 1883 565

The innocence in a lie is the sign of sincere belief in something.'?

We always love only our desire and not what we desire.'*P
Time feels different in the dark than in the light.

And wherever I see the sticky fingers of hucksters, I prefer to draw the short straw.!"!

There before you lies the black sad sea – you must cross that, too! Zarathustra 3.14?

Crumpled houses, absurdly resembling a child's toy: if only a soul would shove them back in the box again! – crumpled souls

Intimate and inclusive, but lowly, like doors which let in only

lower things.!??

Spoiled by many puny triumphs – he has always had it easy: he never became familiar with the best kind of seriousness.!

44

Human beings must become more evil – this is the greatest sorrow of the one who knows! And anyone who wants to create superior humans must make them even more evil – this is the suffering of those who create and are benevolent!

Oh Zarathustra advocate of life! You must also be the advocate of suffering! I cannot exempt you from hell – the under-

world must rise up against you, the shades must still bear witness: "Life is torture."

A lustful eye – nourishment for a bilious soul!

When a big city expands into the country, it does not bring fertilizer to the land but rather corruption and horror.

566 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Where have I witnessed the schooling and upbringing of people who are one day supposed to command? With doctrines of obedience, they had to flatter and feign their way into

the company of those who obey.

Your virtues do not suit your bodies: your bodily ailments accuse the virtues that you gloat about.

Sickened as much by street talking as by street walkers: and precisely these are your most secret sicknesses.

There is great hypocrisy among you: those who command pretend to have the virtues of those who obey.

I try to persuade where I should be in command: this is what my bad education wants. This kind of persuasion is no better than flattery – here superior people are flattering their inferiors.

When everything goes as we will, it also goes as we wish.!?° Everything from the past is a text with a hundred meanings and interpretations and truly! a path into many futures! yet those who give the future a single meaning also determine the single meaning of the past.

"It is not yet time for me to play the fool" says Zarathustra,

when the fool says: "Throw everything away, dance and act as a human being would toward yourself and us."

For some, solitude is a sick person fleeing, for others, solitude

is fleeing from a sick person.

These people drive the masses insane and make them puff themselves up so that their barrels overflow – they serve tyrants: and those people make tyrants puff themselves up and

jump around until they burst – thus do they serve the masses.

22 END 1883 567

This man laughs like a lightning bolt – but afterward he

rumbles for a long time, like thunder
 Contented sows or dying gladiators – don't you have any
 other options?
 Gravediggers dig themselves into illness; deadly vapors rest
 beneath old excavated earth. It is not good to stir up a
 morass.
 They imitate themselves – this is their second childhood.
 The compassion of the greatest people is firm," like the
 hand-
 shake of a giant.
 Doesn't the sun lament: "I wanted to be a light to them, but
 I put out their eyes – I blinded them!
 "How do I get through the city gate? I have unlearned what
 it is like to live among dwarves."
 The greatest thing about great people is what is maternal in
 them. – The father – this is always only a matter of chance.
 My fury still obeys me.
 Beneath my peak and my snows I find all the regions of the
 living.
 and little children do not always come to him who suffers
 them to come.
 You cough and think that this is an objection to strong
 winds.
 "We want food" you roar: your bellies add "Lots!" to this,
 your lusting eye adds: "Good!"
 568 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS
 What is the basest of all base things? A conclusion, the
 old-
 est and most recent conclusion: "It hurts, therefore it is
 bad."
 Since I have understood this "therefore" and this origin of
 bad things, I have laughed at all your "good and bad"! My
 laughter resounds beyond your "good and bad."
 Beauty hides the man.!
 To become smooth and hard-hearted we must go into the
 crowd, but also we must take along our secret solitude.
 Strewn from star to star like the seed of life?
 Terrible dithyramb of life in Zarathustra 4.
 Suffer chance to come to me! It is innocent like a little
 child.
 To outwit chance and lead it around by the hand.
 Only those who know where they are going also know what
 wind is at their back.
 Two new virtues – wise forgetfulness and the art of setting
 sails according to the wind.!"
 Women are becoming more manly: there are too few men.!*°

In kindness there is a lot of contempt for people, but no trace of hate and love for people.!!*

When the devil sheds his skin, his name also falls away. The bite of conscience!" a bite from God and if this God is a God of love – a love bite?

22 END 1883 569

I see their star and I am delighted: but now they actually think of it as my star.

Don't listen to what they say – but look at the set of their jaws! They may lie with their tongues, but they are still speak-

ing the truth with their mouths!!°?

And what was the point of all nature being created if not that I might have signs I can use to speak with souls!

Now everything is just great! For now hucksters are wearing swords and walrus mustaches, and the regiment itself has gone

over to the bowlegged.!54

This is the black sad sea, like my destiny it lies before me

–

Alas this pregnant listlessness at night! An open eye, but still drunk with sleep and still alien, it looks in my direction.

The sea breathes its warm breath on me, like my destiny, and tosses and turns on the pillow of its crags, it groans as

though its expectations were evil –

I am sad for you, you dark monster, and for your sake I bear a grudge against myself. Alas, that I do not possess enough strength to deliver you from evil dreams!

What are you doing, Zarathustra? Do you want to comfort the sea with your song? Have you already become a compassionate spectator and harbinger of your own future?

What are you doing, love-sick fool, you superblissful trusting man? But, full of trust, you have always walked right up to

all terrible things, even wanting to caress every monster.

A breath of warm air, a bit of soft fur around the claws: – and already seductive tones were pouring from your flute, with great yearning you always approached everything that was alive.

Now you must get to know this monster for my sake!

5709 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Better to trust your destiny, even if it roars from 1000 maws

like a sea, better still if it bares its teeth at you in a

storm than
 such pregnant sullenness each night.!°
 There is nothing more evil than a sleeping ocean and a
 pregnant destiny: how will you get over these black depths
 if
 you don't want to be more evil and more black than they are?
 Whatever you might still encounter will come to you as
 your destiny: the time has passed when you could also still
 encounter a coincidence!
 If you can't pray, then why can't you at least curse?
 I fear you because you laugh while we fight for our lives:
 you look like someone who is certain that he will live.
 Live or die – said Zarathustra.
 And if we get out of this, I want to say: "God is not, and
 Zarathustra taught me this."
 I forgive you your mistrust, yet I would not give a plug
 nickel'5° for your trust.
 You still believe in wonders and wonderworkers, true need
 would also teach you how to pray. The ancient counterfeiter
 of the mind have also minted a counterfeit of your intel-
 lect!" –
 Disgust grips me, I am still only 3 days away from – – –
 Cheerfulness as the secret foretaste of death – it lifts the
 great burden of our task from our shoulders.!°8
 Zarathustra: Where is Zarathustra from? Who are father
 and mother to him? "Destiny and laughter are Zarathustra's
 father and mother; cruel destiny and loving laughter have
 together spawned a scion like that."!°?
 22 END 1883 571
 The sky is on fire, the sea spits at je!60
 a puny community in the middle of nowhere and mist and
 conceit of all Bible-chumpers!® 22 [4]'°?
 Scene on the ship.
 Impression that human beings are becoming diminished.
 His fear increases.
 Death and downfall of the isles.
 Zarathustra seeks himself in the tumult:!!°
 with the contrarians (evil people) the violent ones the
 sculptors the discoverers the fools
 22 [s]!6%
 For did I come to warn against pickpockets and to vilify
 vice?!
 You are being pursued.
 Keep it up: this is a good way to pursue me: up to now suc-
 cess
 has only come to those who are most relentlessly pursued.!66

They are getting fed up with their hating and raging and
they have visions of light on lonely roads that say to them:
"Why not try loving!" –

There is a raging love that is so sweet!"

A shipwreck spat him toward land, on the crest of a wave he
came riding into his promised land!"

By all that is bright and strong and good – this God – – –'®
572 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Next to every warehouse I saw an alehouse: their souls are
chilled, they would like to find warmth in spiced wine or
even

in spicy women.!®

Know this, for someone who creates, wisdom and goodness
is!70 not a characteristic, but rather a means and condition
a contrarian, to himself a bad – spouse

"By accident" – not a good nobleman, even if he is of the
oldest line.!7!

Trumpeters and other butterflies

"Your fate has soured you somewhat – now you rise and
swell up beyond all bounds" – says the fool to Zarathustra.
You call them stilts – but they are pride's strong feet –
long
feet!

Servile and supine, obsequious and obnoxious, queasy and
querulous

"how could I not be like oil and water when I am with you
– always on top! – we would have to be vigorously shaken
up together before it would be otherwise" says Zarathustra
to

the captain, who is surprised at his cheerfulness.!""
whatever lives around you soon becomes part of what lives
in you: it becomes customary. And where you customarily sit
becomes the seat of customs.

ill people and obsessed people

"Thus do I praise myself for my part, and that should be
enough for me. Now it was your turn to praise me."!7?

22 END 1883 573

There are people with skills and people with jobs – but
there are also those who stand on their own, who must stand
up for themselves – or else they fall.!4

– they fall on top of you, like monuments of demigods!

I am Zarathustra the Godless: who speaks here: who is more
godless than I am? then I want to become his disciple.'

people like that have always had to crown themselves –
they always found the priests too cowardly

Telling stories around the evening campfire!"

against noise – it strikes thoughts dead!”’
 with a voice like a stonemason’s chisel
 they creep around everywhere it is diseased and disgusting,
 like lice – why shouldn’t we crack them!
 the greatest danger lies behind us – there in that direc-
 tion,
 where the blessed isles are. We set forth at just the right
 time.
 “Or too late” said Zarathustra.
 to curse all the cowardly devils within you who love to
 whimper and fold their hands and who would like to pray to
 something.
 goats geese and other crusaders, led by the holy spirit!”
 “they will slit you open, Zarathustra: you look like someone
 who has swallowed gold”
 Pity those who would want to entertain others, if this were
 no longer their livelihood?
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 They must fight against the wild animal, hunger – other-
 wise their entertainment would be that of a wild animal –
 aimed at us.!”?
 Their boredom would be a brood hen here
 Common and limited enough for even the smallest of ad-
 vantages, they read the rubbish of good fortune like tea
 leaves
 Yes, they are rich – but their eyes are still thieves’ eyes.
 Rag
 dealers. Vultures. !8°
 My curse – the brotherhood of hatred and lightning bolts.
 I went in search of origins: there I cut myself off from all
 reverence – all around me it became strange and lonely.
 But whatever is reverent in me – blossomed secretly; there
 a tree sprang forth for me, I sit in its shadow, the tree of
 the
 future. !8!
 “I am one who reveres the future”
 relentlessly pursued, never caught!®? putrid tepid rancid
 blood!®?
 You made wolves into dogs and humans themselves into
 8 human pets!#*
 22 [6]
 I respect virtue when it is the caution of those who are
 preg-
 nant: but your virtues are the virtues of those who will
 never
 give birth. !85

All great things walk crooked paths: but these great things
must be seen from a wider perspective: this was their courage,

to take a crooked path toward a single goal.

22 END 1883 575

Great people and great rivers take crooked paths toward
their goal: crooked, but toward their goal. This is what is most

courageous about them, that they still fear what is crooked.

22 [7]

stalwart in war, stalwart in birth: that's what I want in
men

and women:

The best taste is not the one that knows how to taste everything: I love contrary choosy palates and tongues, the ones that

I»

say "I

No one wants her as a gift: so she already needs to sell
herself!!8°

To rule – and no longer to be the servant of a god – this
has survived as a means of ennobling humans

22 [8]!87 On the Will to Suffering.

On the Vision and the Riddle.

On Unchosen Bliss. Before Sunrise. On the Virtue That Diminishes. On Passing By. The Wintersong. On Apostates. The Return Home. On the Three Evils. On the Spirit of Gravity. The Summoning The Convalescent. On the Great Longing. On Old and New Tablets And One More Time! The Other Dance Song. On the Ring of Rings.

[23 = Z II 4. End 1883]

23 [x]

A brief innocent story that nevertheless has caused a lot of mischief: I'll tell it to you – you can tell the part about the mis-

chief to yourselves!

There once was a boy who was told with looks and speeches:

"whatever your father is, this is not your real father!"

This troubled the child and caused him to reflect; and finally he said to himself in his heart of hearts, completely in

secret: "is there nothing finer in the world than a real father?"

And when the child learned to pray, his first prayer was:

"God, please give me a real father!"

Yet the child grew older and his secret love and prayer grew

older with him: the teenage boy grew up among women and priests: –

A teenage boy, living among women and priests, grew profound and shy about love, and even about the word “love” growing profound and thirsty for the dew of love, just like thyme in the night –

thirsty and shivering with thirst and a friend of the night because the night is full of shame and fragrant incense –

His soul itself took on the fragrance of the priests’ incense and

the women’s innocence: yet it was still ashamed of this fragrance.

And just as a typical teenage boy prayerfully desires that a woman love him, so too he prayerfully desired the love of a father

and was ashamed even of his prayer.

23 END 1883 577

And so it came to pass that one day his prayer floated away into

clouds of light, and words descended from the clouds of light:

“Behold, this is my beloved son in whom I am well pleased.”?

Is this possible! the teenage boy said. I, the beloved son of

him, to whom I just prayed for a father? God my father! Is this

possible?

This ancient all-powerful Jewish god with furrowed brow

and parted lips – is my father! Can this be possible?

But he says it himself, and he has never yet lied: what can I

do! I have to believe him!

Yet if I am his son, then I am God: yet if I am God, how am I human? – It is not possible – but I have to believe him!

The human in me – this is surely nothing but God’s need

for love: for just as I have thirsted for a father, so he has surely

thirsted for his children.

That I am human, this is surely because of humans: I am meant to lure them to my father –

– to lure them into loving: oh these fools who have to be lured into loving!

They must love God: this is an easy doctrine and a pleasant one – to us children of God, a light yoke is given to bear:

we

must do what we most like to do.

This doctrine and wisdom is easy to grasp: even the poor in spirit may reach out their hands to it

Many things about humans aren't very divine: if we take a shit,? how are we supposed to be God in that moment?

But (it) is even worse with the other kind of shit called sin:

humans want to keep it with them always and not to let go of it.

But I guess I have to believe it: it is possible to be God and

still to take a shit: so I shall teach them to let go of their shit

and become gods.

23 [2]

I recently drank of ancient wisdom, an unimaginably ancient heady wine of wisdom.

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23 [3]* On Fame.

Sensuality is one thing, giving birth something else. Ask women! Having a good time is not the point of giving birth.' Pain makes hens and artists cluck. Sensuality stammers —: now hear me stammer my words on fame.

It is sensual, to press our hand into millennia as if into wax.

Sensual, to write on the will of millennia as if on bronze. It is sensual to melt stars of the future in the goblet of our

will: sensual, reverently to shake out worlds on the rugs of eternity beneath us.

23 [41°

One! Midnight begins! Wafting from afar, from the deep world below — does midnight's word seek its final resting place where I am, the hermit's place?

Two! The final resting place of the deep world — for is it really a hermit's pinnacle?" When it resounds through my ears

and blood and marrow, does it seek — does it seek and still find its peace?

Three!

23 [5]?

On the Ways of the One Who Knows.

"How did you, oh Zarathustra, come to your wisdom: did you fly there? — this you ask of me — so that we may learn from you how we can fly to our wisdom?"

You asked well: you should also be taught well. Anyone who

asks a good question is already more than halfway to an answer.

I have come to my wisdom through many ways and means,
I did not climb to the pinnacle on a ladder and staircase,
to

this place where my eyes roamed into the distance that is mine.

And I never asked people: I asked and tried out the ways for myself. My entire journey was trying things out and asking.

23 END 1883 579

Among people I was always the well-concealed one: whether I climbed or flew or stood and paused: they did not see me with their eyes.

They did not hear me with their ears: and often I listened for an echo but I heard only – praise.'

I spoke directly into their ears when I embarked on to new terrifying seas: is that how I concealed it? Yet now, when I wandered into new terrifying deserts before their very eyes

—

who saw me wander?

And whenever I climbed rope ladders into many a window,
when-

ever I rode many a mast with nimble legs: I remained well
con-

cealed from them, along with my wicked deeds and adventures. It often seemed to me to be malicious bliss, to sit on the highest masts, like a flame: maybe a tiny light, but still a great

comfort for exhausted voyagers and castaways.'°

I learned another kind of blissfulness and wickedness whenever a thawing wind blew: so that my torrent rose ever higher

and my ice built up to towering heights – then I rejoiced.

I found enough weak and gentle people – they call themselves good and deal gently even with virtue; I found enough hypocrites as well, who misuse the name of justice.

I heard self-deceivers speak to me, whose lies rest innocently

on hearts and tongues; even many parasites greedily pushed their way in to join the feast of my wisdom.

23 [6]

You should not drink until you are thirsty: and you should not dance until the spirit moves you. And only learn how to lie

so that you understand what truth-telling is!

You should not be driven back to the truth until you are

hungry for it: and when you have drunk your fill of the good wines of truth, then you will also want to dance.

23 [7]" Prelude.

Oh my brothers! That you first learned silence from me!
And solitude!

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23 [8]'? On the Ultimate Consolation.

Behold, how everything was set up to be a workshop for creative souls: everything indispensable to creative souls is

there in abundance: even including pain.

23 [9]? The Wintersong. On Passing By. On Rulers. On Those Who Enjoy. On Image-Shapers. On Evil People. On Lawgivers On Discoverers. Before Sunrise (Vow)

On the Vision of the Most Solitary One.

The Other Dance Song. On Solitude. On the Great Longing. On Laughing and Flying. Conversation with Lightning. On Eternity. On Free Will. (Below!)

1. On the Will to Suffer

On Passing By.

Before Sunrise.

Yes! And Amen!

On the Great Longing. The Other Dance Song. Below!

The Wintersong.

23 END 1883

On Pregnancy.

On Solitude.

On Fame.

On Rulers.

On (Teachers) Image-Shapers. On Evil People.

Conversation with Lightning.

On the Vision of the Most Solitary One.

On Laughing (and the Spirit of Gravity).

Song of the One Who Flies.

On Lawgivers (Breaking of the Tablets)

On Those Who Enjoy.

On Discoverers (Chance)

23 [10]

2. On Examined Riddles.

4. Before Sunrise. 5 6

. On the Virtue That Diminishes ("Powerful People").

. On Apostates. 7. On Passing By. 8. On the Single Victory.

9. On the Ways of the One who Knows.

10. The Wintersong. 11. On the Great Longing. 12. The Return

Home. 13. On the Three Evils. 14. The Other Dance Song. 15.

The New Tablets.

16. On the Spirit of Gravity.

17. On Convalescence. 21. And One More Time!

22. On the Ring of Rings.

(18-20 are missing)!

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– On the Will to Suffer.

On Examined Riddles. – On Unchosen Bliss – Before Sunrise.

– On the Virtue That Diminishes

– On Apostates. – On Passing By. On the Will to Victory. –

The Wintersong. On the Great Longing. – The Return Home. –

On the Three Evils. – The Other Dance Song. – The New Tablets

– On the Spirit of Gravity.

– The Convalescent. And One More Time! On the Ring of Rings.
the Summoning Up

On the Vision of the Most Solitary One.

On the Will for the Ring.

On the Great Longing.

And One More Time!

On the Ring of Rings.

On Consolation in Magnanimity (“Pain”)

Abolition of Sin (because no God)

(only a parable)

On the Ultimate Consolation Without Sin. On Princes and
Peoples –

[24 = Mp XVII 1b. Winter of 1883–1884]

24 [1]

That it is difficult to get close to the Greeks, that after
study-

ing them for a long time we feel even more distant from
them:

this is the proposition and the entirely personal frustra-
tion

with which I wish to begin my observations about the Greeks
as connoisseurs of human nature. We can live with them for a
good while, while holding beliefs that are opposite to
theirs

and we learn that our alienation? is more instructive than
our feeling of familiarity

perhaps a Greek would experience the way we have delved
deeply in uncovering what is human to be an impiety against
nature, a shameless act. Conversely, we feel alienated –
yvapn;?

to hear “where there is knowledge, action must follow” and
that

virtue should be bliss, this sounds so strange and implausible to

us that we do a double take to see if it was meant as a joke. It is

as if they had given the intellect another layer of skin.

24 [2] philosophical legacy of classical antiquity: – “purpose”

– God and human (the point of view before Copernicus)

– pleasure as motive

– logic, the overvaluing of consciousness.

– the soul

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there is no “thing in itself” any more than there can be “absolute knowledge.”

I replace fundamental truths with fundamental probabilities – provisionally accepted guidelines by which to live and

think

these guidelines not arbitrary but rather correspond to an average degree of habituation.

Habituation is the result of a selection made by my various affects, all of which, during this process, wanted to have a sense

of well-being and to preserve themselves.

24 [3] to observe creative power

how much it sacrifices of the organism (often destructive)

how it, when impregnating, transforms another organism

and puts it into greatest danger.

The degrees of creative power

1) actors, creating figures out of themselves, e.g., la Faustin*

2) poets sculptors painters 3) teachers – Empedocles 4) conquerors 5) lawgivers (philosophers)

generally, the type has yet to be found, except in the lowest

levels: the history of suffering and joy has yet to be documented. False positions e.g., philosophers who position themselves

externally – but this is only a temporary condition and

is necessary for being pregnant.

24 [4]>® The Eternal Recurrence. A Book of Prophecy.

I. Presentation of the doctrine and of its theoretical pre-suppositions and consequences.

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3. Potential consequences of it being believed (it brings

everything to the point of upheaval)

a) Means of enduring it b) Means of eliminating it

Time of greatest danger.

Founding of an oligarchy above the peoples and their interests: education for the sake of a universally human politics. Counterpart of Jesuitism.

24 [5]

On the emergence of logic

original chaos of ideas

ideas that fit together remained, most of them perished – and are perishing.”

Creating – as selection and finishing of what has been selected.

(This is what is essential in every act of will?)

24 [6]

I have always felt a sense of decline in regard to German culture.

this often made me treat the entire phenomenon of European culture unfairly, because I had become familiar with a culture in decline.

the sound of Kant('s) senile and Chinese-like music is fading out,

The Germans are always a little late in arriving: they make things profound, e.g.

dependence on foreign countries (how polyphonic!): e.g.,

Kant – Rousseau – sensualists Hume – Swedenborg

Schopenhauer – Indic peoples and Romanticism, Voltaire.

Wagner – French cult of ghastliness and great opera, Paris and escape back to original conditions. (sister-marriage

Law of latecomers (province after Paris, Germany after France,

such that, of all people, Germans discovered what is Greek

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the more we develop the strength of a drive, the greater the inclination to try to hurl ourselves into its opposite?

Wagner's style of decadence: the single phrase becomes sovereign, subordination and orientation become random. Bourget p. 25.10

24 [7]

both of the greatest philosophical points of view (discovered

by Germans) that of becoming, of evolution

that is oriented around the value of existence (but the pathetic

form of German pessimism must first be overcome!

brought together by me in a decisive way

everything becomes and eternally returns

– slipping away is not possible!

Supposing we could judge value, what would be the result?
the thought of r(ecurrence) as principle of selection, in
ser-

vice to force (and barbarism!!) Humankind's ripeness for
this thought.!!

Enlightenment concerning the fact that there is no thing in
itself and

The 1) no knowledge in itself!

great 2) no good and evil in itself!

nega 3) no goal and no origin!

-tions.

The essence of the organic is the least slippery concept.

Purposes as accompanying phenomena of needs. Even the
philosophies: our need right now is to de-moralize the
world:

otherwise we could not to live anymore. The absolute "un-
free-

dom of the wiill)," interpreted morally, arouses resistance.

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24 [8]

With respect to the feeling of power, humans can be divided
into

A) pitiful people: those for whom the smallest satisfac-
tion is already enough. Proud people, even "good
people."

B) dissatisfied people, who want satisfaction outside
themselves

C) Those who believe themselves to be full of power

D) etc.

24 [9] Psychology of Error! ?

Whenever we do something, a feeling of force emerges, often
preceding what is done, in envisioning what is to be done
(as

when we catch sight of an enemy, an obstacle that we believe
we are capable of dealing with): always accompanying this
feel-

ing. We instinctively think that this feeling of force ought
to

be the cause of the action, that it ought to be "the force."
Our

belief in causality is the belief in force and its effect; a
transfer-

ence of our experience; whereby we identify force with the
feeling of force. – Yet nowhere does the force move things,

the force that is felt "does not set the muscles in motion."
"We
have no idea, no experience, of such a process." – "We experience just as little of the necessity of a movement as of the force
as something that makes things move." Force ought to be that which compels! "We only experience that one thing follows another – we experience neither the compulsion, nor the choice, that one thing follows another." Causality is first created through the projection of compulsion into the process of following. A certain "comprehension" emerges thereby, i.e., we have anthropomorphized the process for ourselves, made it "more familiar": that which is familiar is the habitual familiarity of a feeling of force that is conjoined to human compelling*">

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24 [10]

It is true that "necessity{" can also mean "every time when A occurs, B will follow. Degree of probability (certainty) whereby the occurrence of what follows may be expected. This certainty rests on experience: B has always followed A, there

has never been a non-B that has followed A. Conceptual support through the fact that processes of following, which are of

a nature similar to AB, are cited to produce the certainty that

B will follow A."!°

"It is also the case that the sensation" of force cannot be derived from motion. Sensation in general cannot be derived from motion.!?

Also supporting this is merely an illusory experience: in a substance (brain), sensation is engendered by transferred movement (stimuli). But engendered? Would that then have proved that the sensation did not yet exist there at all? so that

its arising would have to be understood as a creative act of the

motion that has taken place? The state of this substance, in which there is no sensation, is only a hypothesis! no experience!!?

– therefore sensation as property of substance:

there

are sensing substances."?®

"Do we have experience of certain substances not having sensation? No, it is just that we do not experience that they

have it. It is impossible to derive sensation from non-sensing

substances."?! – Oh such hastiness!??

24 [11]

"I want to go": but 1) I have to go, and the willing" is only

something incidental which produces no motion at all, a prior

image. 2) This image is unbelievably raw and indeterminate compared to what happens, it is conceptual and completely general, so that innumerable realities overlap underneath it.

Therefore it cannot be the cause of what happens. – Purposes are to be eliminated.

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24 [12]

When an officer gives the order "present arms," the soldiers do it. He commands, they want to do it now. In reality, what they do now is something different for each one of them: but to crude organs it looks the same. Those who act purposefully

often find those purposes fulfilled: i.e., they see crudely and

do not at all recognize what truly happens. That the world of

what happens corresponds to our incomplete image of what happens,

overlaps with it, this is the faith of teachers of purpose.

The less that is known, the easier it is to maintain this faith.

24 [13]

"In the development of thought there must have come a point when it became conscious, such that whatever were designated as properties of things were sensations of the perceiving

subject: at this point, the properties ceased to belong to the

thing. "The thing in itself" remained. The distinction between

things in themselves and the thing for us was based on the

ancient naive perception that projected energy into the thing:

but analysis has shown that even force was imaginatively ascribed to the thing, and in the same way – substance. “The thing affects a subject?” Root of the idea of substance in lan-

guage, not in that which is external to us! The thing in itself is

no problem at all!”°

What exists should be thought of as sensation that has, as its foundation, nothing else lacking in sensation.”®

In motion no new content is given to sensation. With respect to content, what exists?” cannot be motion: therefore form of existence.???

NB. The explanation of events can be attempted, first: by representing images of events that precede the events (purposes)

second: by representing images that follow the events (the mathematical-physical explanation.

These approaches should not be confused with each other.

Therefore: the physical explanation, which is the picturing of

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the world out of sensation and thought, cannot itself derive sensation and thought again and make them emerge: rather, physics must consistently construe even the sensing world as lacking sensation and purpose – all the way up to the most superior humans. And the teleological explanation is only a history of purposes and is never physicalist!

24 [14]

A multiplicity of forces, conjoined through a common nutritive process, is what we call “life.” All so-called feeling, repre-

senting, thinking is part of this nutritive process as a means of

making it possible, i.e., 1) a resistance to all other forces 2) an

arrangement of these according to shapes and rhythms 3) an evaluation in regard to incorporation or separation.*°

Humans believe in “being” and in things because they are form-building and rhythm-making creatures.

The shapes and forms that we see, and in which we believe we have things contained, are all absent. We simplify ourselves and we conjoin some “impressions” through figures that

we create.

Those who close their eyes discover that a form-building drive continues to function and that innumerable things are attempted that do not correspond to any reality.

2. Humans are rhythm-making creatures. They project all events into these rhythms, it is a way of gaining control of the

"impressions."

The way they nourish themselves and acquire things is to shape them into "forms" and rhythms: comprehension is at first

only creation of "things." Knowledge a means of nourishment.

24 [15]

Science does not ask what drove us to this willing: in fact, it denies that willing has occurred and thinks that something

entirely different has happened – simply put, that the belief

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in will and purpose is an illusion. It does not inquire into the

motivations for an action, as if these had already existed in our

consciousness prior to the action: rather, it first divides the

action into a mechanical group of appearances and seeks the prehistory of this mechanical movement – but not in feeling perceiving thinking. That is why it can never accept the explanation:

perception is what was supposed to be explained in the

first place. – Its problem is really this: to explain the world

without resorting to perceptions as causes: for that would certainly

mean: seeing perceptions as causes of perceptions.

Its

task is in no way accomplished.

Thus: either no will – the hypothesis of science – or free will. Latter assumption the prevailing feeling that is incapable

for us, even if the hypothesis were proved.

The popular belief in cause and effect rests on the presupposition

that free will is the cause of every effect: before this we do

not have the feeling of causality. Thus, this presupposition

underlies even the feeling that every cause is not an effect but rather in the first place always a cause – if the will is the cause. “Our acts of will are not necessary” – this is contained in the concept “will” The effect after the cause is what is necessary – that’s how we feel. –That even our willing must absolutely be like that, is a hypothesis?! But willing: = purposeful willing. Purpose contains a value judgment. Where do value judgments come from? Is the basis a consistent standard of “pleasant and painful”?

But in innumerable cases we do not make something painful until we project our value judgment into it.

Range of moral value judgments: they play a role in almost every sense impression. The world is colored for us through them.

We have projected the purpose and the value: through this we have within us an immense /atent force: but comparing values reveals that opposing things were seen (as) valuable, that many codes of values have existed.

therefore nothing valuable “in itself”

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the analysis of codes of values reveals their establishment as the establishment of conditions of existence for narrowly defined groups (and often mistakenly): for the sake of preservation.

in observing contemporary humans, it becomes obvious that we apply widely differing value judgments, and that there is no more creative force left in there – the basis: “the condition of existence” is now absent from moral judgments. The judgments are much more superfluous. They have not been this painful in a long time. –They are becoming arbitrary. Chaos.

Who creates the goal that remains ascendant above humankind and also above the individual? In earlier times, the point of morality was preservation. But now no one wants to preserve anything anymore, there is nothing left there to preserve.

Therefore an experimental morality, to give ourselves a goal.??

species-preserving

24 [16]" About the Origin of our Value Judgments.

We can spatially analyze our own bodies, and then we get exactly the same representation of them that we do of the solar

system, and we no longer notice the distinction between the organic and the inorganic

Hymn to value judgment.

In earlier times, the movements of the stars and planets were

explained as effects of consciously purposeful beings: we don't

need this anymore, and it has been a long time since we have regarded purpose-setting consciousness as adequate for explaining even bodily movements and personal transformations.' The

vast majority of movements have nothing whatsoever to do with

consciousness: also nothing to do with perception. Perceptions and

thoughts are very limited and rare in relation to the countless

number of events in every moment. Conversely, we perceive that

a purposefulness prevails in the smallest event, for which our best

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knowledge is inadequate, a cautiousness, a selection, a collation,

compensation etc. In short, we discover an activity that would

have to be attributed to a vastly superior and more comprehensive

intellect than the one of which we are conscious. We learn to

think less highly of all consciousness: we unlearn how to make

ourselves responsible for ourselves, since we, as conscious, purpose-setting beings, are only the smallest part of this process. We

perceive almost nothing of the numerous influences in every moment, e.g., air electricity: enough forces could exist that con-

tinuously influence us, even though they never enter into our perception. Pleasure and pain are such rare and limited phenomena compared with the countless stimuli that a cell transmits, or an organ transmits, to another cell, or to another organ. It is a phase of modesty in respect to consciousness. We finally understand the conscious I itself merely as a tool in service to that superior, more comprehensive intellect: and here we can ask whether all conscious willing, all conscious purposes, all value judgments are not perhaps just means through which something essentially different must be achieved than what appears within consciousness. We tend to think: it has to do with our pleasure and displeasure — — — but pleasure and displeasure could be the means by which we would have to accomplish something that lies outside our consciousness — — — It is to be demonstrated how much all that is conscious remains on the surface: how action, and the image of action, differ, how little is known of what precedes an action: how fanciful our feelings “freedom of the will” “cause and effect” are: how thoughts are only images, just as words are only signs of thoughts: the impossibility of explaining every action: the superficiality of all praise and blame: how essential invention and imagination are, in the place where we consciously live, how we speak in all of our phrases about inventions (including affects), and how h(uman) connections rest upon a transmission and continual re-creation of these inventions: while fundamentally the real connections (through procreation) continue on their unknown

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path. Are human beings really changed by this belief in common inventions? Or is the complete system of ideas and value judgments merely itself an expression of unknown changes? So, do willing, purposes, thoughts, values really exist? Is all

of con-
scious life perhaps only a mirror image? And even when a
value
judgment appears to define a human, does essentially some-
thing entirely different happen? In short: assuming we could
successfully explain that which is purposeful in the work-
ings
of nature without assuming a purpose-setting I: could ulti-
mately our purpose-setting, our willing, etc. perhaps be
only a
sign language for something essentially different – namely
something not-willing and unconscious?’ Merely the most sub-
tle impression of this natural purposefulness of the organ-
ic, but
nothing different from it?
And briefly put: perhaps the entire development of the
mind has to do with the bod): it is its history that is be-
coming
tangible, a history of a superior body being formed. The or-
ganic
is still ascending to higher levels. Our craving for know-
ledge
of nature is a means by which the body wants to perfect it-
self.
Or rather: hundreds of thousands of experiments are per-
formed, in order to change nutrition, ways of living, life-
styles
of the body: consciousness and the value judgments it con-
tains, all kinds of pleasure and displeasure, are signs of
these
changes and experiments. In the end, this has nothing at all
to do
with humans: they must be overcome.*’

24 [17]

They think of themselves as being present at the emergence
of organisms: what is it about this process that has been per-
ceivable through sight and touch? What can be rendered in
numbers? Which rules manifest themselves in the movements?
Thus: humans want to categorize every event as an event for
sight and touch, consequently as movements: and they want to
find formulas that will simplify the enormous mass of these
experiences. Reduction of all events to something that can
be
measured by human senses? and mathematicians.

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This has to do with an inventory of human experiences: assuming that humans, or rather the human eye and conceptual ability, might have been eternal witnesses to all things.

24 [18]*°

Science – this has been up to now the elimination of the complete confusion of things by means of hypotheses which “explain” everything – therefore motivated by the intellect’s

aversion to chaos. – This same aversion possesses me when I observe myself: I, too, would like to imaginatively represent to

myself the inner world by means of a schema and move beyond intellectual confusion. Morality was just this sort of simplification:

it taught that humans were recognizable, familiar. – Now

we have destroyed morality – we have again become completely obscure to ourselves! I know that I know nothing of myself: Physics reveals itself as an act of charity for the emotions:!* sci-

ence (path to knowledge) gains a new allure after morality has

been eliminated – and because here alone we find consistency,

we have to orient our lives around it in order to preserve consistency for ourselves. This results in a kind of practical

contemplation about the conditions of our existence as those who

know.

24 [19]*?

Morality of truthfulness in the herd. “You should be knowable,*? express what is within you through clear and constant

signs – otherwise you are dangerous: and if you are evil, the

worst thing for the herd is your ability to disguise yourself. We

despise what is secret what is unknowable. – Consequently you must consider yourself to be knowable, you must not be concealed from yourself, you must not believe in your ability to

change.” Thus: the demands of truthfulness presuppose a person’s knowability and stability. Actually, the point of edu-

cation

is to bring a member of the herd to a particular belief concern-

ing the essence of human beings: it first creates this belief and in

addition it demands "truthfulness."

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24 [20] *4

The Faith in "Affects." Affects are a construction of the intellect, a fictional account of causes that do not exist.

All cor-

poreal general feelings® that we do not understand are intellectually-

tually interpreted, i.e., a reason is sought as to why we feel this

or that way, in persons, experiences etc. thus, something dele-

terious dangerous foreign is assumed as if it were the cause of

our bad mood: actually it is added to the bad mood for the sake of being able to think about our condition. – Frequent

blood flows to the brain accompanied by the feeling of suffo-

cation are interpreted as anger: people and things that enrage

us are triggers for the physiological state. – After the fact,

once we have grown accustomed to them, certain processes and general feelings are associated so regularly that the sight of

certain processes incites this same state of general feeling and

accompanies any kind of circulation blockage, production of semen etc.: thus through proximity: we then say "the affect is

triggered."

Judgments are already present in "pleasure" and "displeasure": stimuli are differentiated according to whether they do

or don't enhance the feeling of power.

24 [21]*°

The faith in willing. It is a faith in miracles to posit a thought

as the cause of a mechanical movement. The consistency of science-

ence demands that, after we have made the world conceivable

for ourselves through tiny images, we also make affects desires

willing etc. conceivable to ourselves, i.e., we reject them and

we treat them as mistakes of the intellect.

24 [22]*"

Denunciation did not become a part of punishment until certain penalties were attached to despicable people (e.g. slaves). Those who were punished most often were despicable people and finally there was something to denounce in punishment itself. –

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24 [23]®

We believe thinking to be the strongest and most consistent activity at all levels of life, in every perception and apparent

suffering as well! In this way, thinking obviously becomes most powerful and most demanding, and in time tyrannizes all other forces. In the end, it becomes "the passion in itself."

24 [24]

– – – thus selflessness would further evil. Virtue would be foolishness and self-contradiction. Those who would want to make human beings better could not do so by means of their goodness but rather by resisting their charitable inclinations.

24 [25]"

supreme fairness and generosity as state of weakness (the New Testament and the early Christian community) (revealing itself as complete *bêtise*" in the Englishmen Darwin, Wallace).

Those of you with superior natures, your fairness is driving you to suffrage universel'! etc., your "humanity" is driving you

to generosity in response to crimes and stupidity. /n time you

will make possible the victory of stupidity and of thoughtless

people

(Comfort and stupidity –the means) (e.g., Bismarck – Externally: age of brutal wars, revolutions, explosions Internally. ever growing weakness of human beings. Events as triggers. Parisians as the European extreme."

Consequence.

1) Barbarians,

first, of course, in shaping culture up to now (e.g.,

Dühring)

2) Sovereign individuals (where concentrations of barbarian force are combined with a lack of restraint regarding everything that has come before)

Age of the greatest stupidity, brutality and misery of the masses, and of the most superior individuals.

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24 [26]?

At our core: ? not knowing, which way out? Emptiness.

Attempt to get beyond this through intoxication.

Intoxication as music

Intoxication as cruelty in the tragic enjoyment of the downfall of what is most noble.

Intoxication as blind fervor for individual people (or ages) (as hatred, etc.)

Attempt to work mindlessly as a tool of science.

to open our eyes to the many small pleasures e.g., even as someone who knows. Modesty in regard to ourselves.

to generalize modesty concerning ourselves into a kind of pathos

mysticism, the lustful enjoyment of the eternal void.

art for its own sake "le fait," "pure knowing" as narcotics for disgust with ourselves 36

some sort of regular work, some sort of small stupid fanaticism

the confusion of all means – illness through universal immoderation. (Debauchery kills pleasure.)

1) weakness of the will as result.

2) having felt, by contrast, extreme pride and the humiliation of minor weaknesses.

24 [27]" Morality for Moralists.

1 Little knowledge of our effect

false presuppositions concerning our motivations

2 Exchange of moral labels; good people not wanting to see.

Motives of moralists, self-knowers, confessors etc.

4 Health and illness and their manifestations in good and evil people. The body as master teacher. Morality as sign language.®

5 Evil as organic function. Good people as degeneration, stagnation etc. "Altruism."

Ww

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6 Conscience of the community and of the individual. At the end, the individual as majority.

7 The future of morality. Religions.

24 [28] My Innovations. Further development of pessimism

the pessimism of the intellect.

moral) criticism, disintegration of the final consolation
knowing the signs of decline

veiled by delusion every strong action

culture isolated, unjust, thereby strong

1.) My ambition to counter the decline and the increasing
weakness of personality. I sought a new center.

2.) Impossibility of this ambition recognized!

3.) After this / went further along the path of disintegration,

– there I found new sources of strength for individuals. We
must be destroyers! – –

I recognized that the state of disintegration in which individual

beings can perfect themselves as never before – is a reflection

and exemplary case of universally shared existence.”

Theory of chance, the soul a selective and self-nourishing
being

exceptionally clever and continuously creative (this creative

power usually overlooked! understood only as “passive”)

I recognized the active force that which is creative in the
midst of chance

– chance is itself merely the collision of creative impulses

I held up eternal recurrence against the numbing feeling of
general disintegration and imperfection!“

24 [29]

Fear of death as an European illness.

Fear easy to instill, even in stupid fish Herd animals
mainly fearful,

hearing highly attuned to alarm signals.

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Moral judgments (fear and aversion) very different, inculcated
early. The art of rendering judgments against others,
something all teachers of virtue have in common.

24 [30]

to connect skepticism with heroic feelings

Skepticism of weakness and skepticism of courage

To imagine a human being without morals, who everywhere
brings forth even the opposite judgment

Napoleon.

24 [31]%

Compassion and love for humankind as development of the
sex drive.

Justice as development of the drive for revenge.

Virtue as pleasure in resistance, will to power.
Honor as public recognition of that which has affinity and equal power.

aversion to the calculating frogs

All virtues physiological states namely the main organic functions perceived as necessary, as good.

All virtues are actually refined passions and intensified states.

24 [32]

Unfreedom or freedom of the will? There is no will.®4

The individual is something completely novel and someone who creates novelty.

24 [33]°°

Individuals are something absolute, all actions entirely their own.

In the end, they take the values for judging their actions from within themselves: this is because even those words that

have been passed down must be interpreted by them in a completely individual way for themselves. The interpretation of the

formula is at least personal, even if it creates no formula: as

interpreters they are still creative.

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24 134"

All actions must first be prepared in as mechanical a way as possible, before they are willed. Or: "purpose" does not appear

in the brain until, for the most part, everything is prepared for its

completion. Purpose an "inner" "stimulus" – nothing more.

There is no "will": this is merely the understanding's simpli-

fying concept, like "matter."

24 [35]

Our sense organs as causes of the external world? But they themselves are indeed also nothing but effects of our "senses."

– Our image of the eye is a product of the eye.

24 [36]

1) There is no matter" – no atom p. 53

2) There is no space. (The prejudgment "empty of matter" is what created the assumption of spaces in the first place.

3) There is also no cause and effect. Rather: if a tension

occurs here, a release of tension must occur in the whole rest of the world. (That the tension occurs is in turn the "consequence" of a release of tension elsewhere.) But it cannot possibly be a sequence: rather, simultaneously, tension increases here and decreases there. The processes that are actually connected to each other must transpire absolutely simultaneously. We single out a point as "effect," e.g., when a person falls over after being shot. But this is an immense chain of connected "effects." If time were necessary for the sake of the "effect," then there would be a plus without the corresponding minus, at least for moments: i.e., the force would sometimes wax sometimes wane Vogt p. 654 we should presuppose a living rhythm, not cause and consequence!

4) we must not assume any absolute creation, because nothing can be comprehended with this "concept." To create force, that is not there, suddenly out of nothing: this is no Aypothesis at all! (contra Vogt p. 2 etc.)

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5) We can recognize the emergence of the organism from the "moral drives" of humans, reasoning from this developing process back to the development of the lowest organisms. Moral drives are the history of selfregulation and function-building of a whole (state community): how is the individual given a feeling of function?

The individual is an egg. Colony-building is the task of every individual

24 [37]"°

Omnia naturalia facienti sunt indifferentia, sed abstinenti vel neganti bona aut mala."

Reference Matter

Notes

The following symbols are used throughout the text and notes:

[] || t} ()

NL

Deletion by Nietzsche

Addition by Nietzsche

Addition by the translators

Addition by the editors

(Colli and Montinari)

Unfinished or incomplete sentence or thought

Underlined once by Nietzsche Underlined twice or more by Nietzsche

Books in Nietzsche's personal library

Variants and editions of Nietzsche's works are referred to by

the following abbreviations:

CW

KGB

KGW

KSA

Le

Pd Pm

The Complete Works of Friedrich Nietzsche

Briefwechsel: Kritische Gesamtausgabe Werke: Kritische Gesamtausgabe

Werke: Kritische Studienausgabe Twenty-volume 1894 Leipzig edition of Nietzsche's works (Großoktav-Ausgabe) Preliminary draft

Printer's manuscript (clean final copy of handwritten MS)

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Sd Se

NOTES

Second draft Subsequent emendation

Titles of Nietzsche's works are referred to by the following abbreviations:

AC

BGE

BT D DD DS

EH GM

HAH

HL

JS MM

NCW

SE

TI

The Anti-Christian

Beyond Good and Evil

The Birth of Tragedy

Dawn
 Dionysus Dithyrambs
 David Strauss the Confessor and the
 Writer
 Ecce Homo
 On the Genealogy of Morality Human, All Too Human
 On the Utility and Liability of History
 for Life
 The Joyful Science
 Mixed Opinions and Maxims Nietzsche Contra Wagner Schopen-
 hauer as Educator Twilight of the Idols Unfashionable Obser-
 vations The Wagner Case
 Richard Wagner in Bayreuth The Will to Power
 The Wanderer and His Shadow Thus Spoke Zarathustra
 Unless another volume of the Complete Works is indicated,
 all

cross-references to fragments are ones that appear in this volume.

References to the following works will also appear in the notes:

Flügel

Felix Flügel, A Practical Dictionary of the English and
 German Languages in Two Parts! Praktisches Englisch-
 Deutsches und Deutsch-Englisches Wörterbuch in zwei
 Theilen. Leipzig: Julius E. Richter; Hamburg: John
 Augustus Meissner, 1852. This is an expanded edition
 NOTES TO PAGES 3–4 607

of his father Johann Gottfried Flügel's A Complete
 Dictionary of the English and German and German
 and English Languages in Two Volumes/Vollständige
 Englisch-Deutsches und Deutsch-Englisches Wörterbuch
 in zwei Theilen, first published in 1830.

Grimm Deutsches Wörterbuch von Jacob und Wilhelm Grimm.
 16 Bde. in 32 Teilbänden. Leipzig 1854-1961. Quellen-
 verzeichnis Leipzig 1971. Online version at <http://www.woerterbuchnetz.de/DWB>.

Pfeiffer Friedrich Nietzsche – Paul Ree – Lou von Salome:
 Die

Dokumente ihrer Begegnung. Auf der Grundlage der
 einstigen Zusammenarbeit mit Karl Schlechta und
 Erhart Thierbach ("The documentation of their
 meetings." Based on previous collaboration with Karl
 Schlechta and Erhart Thierbach). Edited by Ernst
 Pfeiffer. Frankfurt on Main: Insel Verlag, 1970.

{1 =N V 9a. N VI 1}

1. "solitudo continuata dulcescit"] "Continued solitude

grows

sweet" {Cf. Luigi Boniforti (1817-1909), *I lago Maggiore e suoi din-*

torni: *Corografia e guida storica, artistica, industriale* ("Lake Mag-

giore and its surroundings: *Chorography and historical, artistic,*

industrial guide") (Milan: Brigola, 1871), 239.}

2. *Madonna del Sasso*. (Locarno)] *The Pilgrimage Church above the city of Locarno*.

3. {See our notes on the translation of the pronoun *man* in the

Translators' Afterword, 726-27.}

4. {These notes are based in part on books by the physicists Johann Karl Friedrich Zöllner (1834-82), *Über die Natur der Come-*

ten: Beiträge zur Geschichte und Theorie der Erkenntniss ("On the

nature of comets: *Contributions to the history and theory of knowl-*

edge") (Leipzig: Engelmann, 1872); and Johann Gustav Vogt (1843-

1920), *Die Kraft: Eine real-monistische Weltanschauung* "Force: A real-

monistic worldview") (Leipzig: Haupt & Tischler, 1878).}

5. *unlearn*] *verlernen* {N has in mind here the deliberate and systematic attempt to discard or forget erroneous habits and opinions.}

608 NOTES TO PAGES 4-6

8. "Suaviter in re, fortiter in me."] "Gentle in action, resolute in

me." A paraphrase of *Fortiter in re, suaviter in modo* ("Res-

olute in action, gentle in manner"), saying of the Jesuit general Claudio

Aquaviva, *Industriae ad curandos animae morbos* ("Curing the illnesses of the soul"), Venice 1606 (according to Büch-

mann).
10. Cf. 311] 34; {1[9]; 311] 224; 22[3]_563; /S 262. {Hereand through-

out these notebooks, wherever Nietzsche uses singular inflection to

describe all members of a species (*wer*/"anyone who"), an ethnicity

(*der Chinese*), or a vocation (*der Dichter*), we have pluralized the

nouns and their possessive referents in order to preserve gender neutrality. For a detailed explanation of our approach, with examples, please see the section "Singular Universals" in the Translators' Afterword, 730-32.}

u. Cf. note to 1[6].

14. Vademecum. Vadetecum] "Go with me. Go with you" {A vade mecum is a handbook for ready reference that someone can carry around.}

Keinem Genueser mehr!

Immer starrt er in das Blaue,
Fernstes lockt ihn allzusehr!

*

Muth! Auf offnem Meer bin ich,

Hinter mir liegt Genua.

Und mit dir im Bund gewinn ich

Goldland und Amerika.

Stehen fest wir auf den Füßen!

Nimmer können wir zurück. Schau hinaus: von fernher grüßen

Uns Ein Tod, Ein Ruhm, Ein Glück!

NOTES TO PAGES 6-8 609

Friend take this book and do not trust*

a Genoese ever again!

What is farthest draws him all too much!

I was as one, I am as two,

Behind us lies Genoa,

And with golden threads I spin

A fortune for myself – Hallelujah!

*Read this book and do not trust {variant to the starred line

above}

the future and America {variant to the double-starred line above}

19. Verse from Lou von Salomé's "Prayer to Life"; she gave N this poem when she left Tautenburg, Cf. Pfeiffer 450.

20. sub specie trecentorum annorum?] {A play on the Latin phrase sub specie aeternitatis, literally "under the aspect of eter-

nity," which since Spinoza has meant "universally true."

Here N

means "under the aspect" or "within the timeframe of 300 years."}

21. A later addition, in part, of already treated or yet to

be

treated topics.

22. neighborliness] Nächstensucht {N means "neighbor" here in the sense of Jesus's second great commandment, "Love your neigh-

bor as yourself" (Matthew 22:39); cf. 1[22]; 17[30].}

Was liegt an Särgen und Leichentüchern!

Dies ist ein Wille, dies ist ein Versprechen,

Dies ist ein letztes Brücken-Zerbrechen,

Dies ist ein Meerwind, ein Ankerlichter,

Ein Räderbrausen, ein Steuer-Richten,

Es brüllt die Kanone, weiß dampft ihr Feuer,

Es lacht das Meer, das Ungeheuer –

25. {Cf. 1[19]; 17[30].}

610 NOTES TO PAGES 8-16

29. Cf. 3[1] 26; {see the Translators' Afterword, 743-44, for notes

on the translation of N's Gemiith}.

30. Dated by Peter Gast "2 October 1882" in the notebook; actually to be dated beginning of August 1882, which may be concluded from Paul Rée's letter of 6 August 1882 to Lou von Salomé (in Tautenburg); cf. Pfeiffer 177.

31. {N's use of the masculine singular universal includes both

men and women. We do not pluralize "medium" here for the sake of clarity.}

Cf. 1[65]; {3[1] 10}.

34. choice] Willkiir {We believe that "choice" best captures these allusions to Kant's technical term in his moral theory.}

36. {Cf. 3[1] 226.}

37. state] Zustand {The negation of the German term in this context indicates the impossibility of isolating any phase within a process}.

38. {Cf. sft] 54-}

39. death] der Tod {Here in nominative case, which we are assuming was meant to be den Tod (in the accusative).}

40. {Cf. 1[78]; sie] 53.}

43. "Faites... terre."] "Get married out of friendship in order

to have children. Love has little to do with progeny. If you see a

human being in front of you that you love more than yourself,

you will be happy. But it is not the woman that one can love

more than oneself, it is the child, it is the innocent being, it is the divine type that vanishes more or less while growing up, but, in the course of some years, brings us back to the perception of an ideal on earth." {Maxime du Camp cites this letter from George Sand of 21 June 1868 in his "Souvenirs littéraires. XIII: Lui et Elle; intérieur de journal," published in *Revue des deux mondes* 52

(15 August 1882): 729.}

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46. {Cf. 11111}; 3[1] 16.}

47. imperiousness] Herrschsucht {Which N sometimes contrasts with Selbstsucht ("selfishness").}

48. {Cf. [111]; 3[1] 17; BGE 139.}

49. women] Frauen {Cf. 311] 351c; 1[50]; 12[1] 92.}.

50. On the Reemergence] Zur Wieder-Entstehung {In not distinguishing between zu and von in N's titles, we follow the usage of

the Stanford edition.}

51. Cf. 311] 15; ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 4.

52. Cf. 311] 13; {4[226]; 12[1] 147; 13[14]; 16[7]}.

61. advocatus diaboli] "devil's advocate"

65. Cf. 1[24, 67]; 3[1] 1225 s[1] 66; 1[43, 108]; 3[1] 50, 49, 8; 1[72,

73]; BGE 129, 133.

66. we know them through and through] ihre Maaße und Gewichte kennen

67. repeating beings] periodische Wesen

68. {Cf. 3[1] so; 22[3]_564; BGE 129.}

69. {Cf. 311] 49; 22[3]_564.}

71. {Cf. 1[88]; 5[1] 61; 1[108].}

72. {Cf. 3[1] 8}

73. will for power] Machtwille

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77. {Cf. 311] 29; 22[3]_563.}

81. menand women] Männer und Frauen

87. women] Frauen

89. {Cf. 1[73]; si] 61; 1[108]. We translate Untergang as "down-

fall" in this volume, but we have changed the verb here to accom-

modate the transitive meaning.}

Spanische Grammatik (Leipzig: Verlag G. A. Gloeckner, 1882);

N

misspells the name of Schilling's publisher.}

Muft du mal drauf beißen.

97. {These works are cited in Friedrich von Hellwald, Kultur-
geschichte in ihrer natürlichen Entwicklung bis zur Gegenwart

("Cultural history in its natural development to the present")

(Augsburg: Lampart, 1876), 8, 9, 13, 65. Hellwald's text was an

important source for N of information concerning Zarathustra;

in fact, N's first reference to Zarathustra (cf. CW 13, 11[195]) fol-

lows closely from this text, p. 169. N's connection with Hell-

wald's text was first discovered by Paolo D'Iorio; cf.

"Beiträge zur

Quellenforschung," Nietzsche-Studien 22 (1993): 395-97.}

98. {Cf. Eduard Hitzig, Untersuchungen über das Gehirn: Abhandlungen physiologischen und pathologischen Inhalts ("Studies

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of the brain: Treatises with physiological and pathological content") (Berlin: August Hirschwald, 1874).}

100. {Cf. Paul von Lilienfeld, Gedanken über die Socialwissenschaften-

schaft der Zukunft ("Thoughts on the social science of the future", 2 vols. (Mitau: E. Behre, 1873).}

101. Cosa... dura!!!} {Beautiful and mortal things/Pass away and do not last!!!} Underlined by N. A verse from Sonnet 248 of the

Canzoniere, also called Rarum vulgare fragmenta, by Petrarch}

Mir fortan und meinem Griff!

Offen ist das Meer: in's Blaue

Treibt mein Genuesser Schiff. OK

Alles wird mir neu und neuer

Hinter mir liegt Genua.

Muth! Stehst du doch selbst am Steuer,

Lieblichste Victoria!

preceded by MM}: Unmoved heart, a mute hand at the helm.
 There [to that place] {I} want to go
 Genoa – that sank, that disappeared!
 [is] [that disappeared, is] Genoa – have I already forgotten
 it?
 Heart, stay unmoved! Hand, [Gloria] stands at my
 Hold the helm, hand! Who stands there at the helm
 for me?
 Ocean and fame [– and death] before me!
 –and Land! Gloria – and
 Gloria! You stand at the helm
 614 NOTES TO PAGE 25
 I want – to go there! Friend
 [Gloria]
 Do not trust a Genoese ever again!
 He is always staring into the blue
 What is farthest draws him all
 too much!
 What is most foreign is dear to me today
 Genoa lies far[s] behind
 To there – or toward death!
 [MM: According to the drafts and attempts cited above, the
 fol-
 lowing transitional version seems possible:]
 That's the way I want to go! Friend, do not trust
 A Genoese ever again!
 He is always staring into the blue
 What is farthest draws him all too much!
 What is most foreign is dear to me today
 Genoa lies far behind
 Gloria! You stand at the helm
 To there – or toward death!
 N V 9, 18-17:
 Open is the sea: into the blue
 Drives my Genoese ship
 To there, and I trust
 Myself from now on and my grip.
 Everything becomes new and newer to me
 Genoa lies behind me:
 And you yourself stand at the helm,
 Dearest Victoria!
 N V, 19:
 ToL.
 I want to go there, and I trust
 Myself and my grip from now on!
 Open is the ocean: into the blue

Drives my Genoese ship.

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Everything becomes new and newer to me

Genoa lies behind me

And you yourself stand at the helm*

Dearest Victoria!

*Courage! You yourself stand at the helm {Variant to the
starred

line above.}

[MM: On the same page is the following variant to the second
strophe:]

What is most foreign is now dear to me

Genoa lies behind me

Courage! She herself stands at the helm.

(MM: This variant was rejected, yet it inspired the change
in the

third line of the second strophe that is depicted above.]

106. Cf. 3[2].

Zu einsam wuchs ich und zu hoch:

Ich warte: worauf wart' ich doch?

OK

Zu nah ist mir der Wolken Sitz:

Ich warte auf den ersten Blitz.

Wen liebt ich so wie dich, geliebter Schatten!

Ich zog dich an mich, in mich – und seitdem

Ward ich beinah zum Schatten, du zum Leibe.

Nur daß mein Auge unbelehrbar ist,

Gewöhnt, die Dinge außer sich zu sehen:

Ihm bleibst du stets das ew'ge "Außer-mir".

Ach, dieses Auge bringt mich außer mich!

Whom have I loved as I love you, beloved shadow!

I pulled you to me, into me – and ever since

I am more shadow than I was before*

You more body than ever before and everyone [sees] [wonders]
says:

616 NOTES TO PAGES 26-27

[Two became one, a shadow and a body

only that my own eye refuses to believe it

This is so] And still – that I for you

*Did I almost become a shadow [forever] only and you

[Almost became] a body: no longer two, [only] our transfor-
mation continues

{Variants to the two starred lines above.}

ur. (Sanctus Januarius)] ("Holy January"). {A pun on Saint
Januarius, the patron saint of Naples.}

112. "Die fröliche Wissenschaft."

(Sanctus Januarius)

Dies ist kein Buch: was liegt an Büchern!

An diesen Särgen und Leichentüchern! Vergangnes ist der
Bücher Beute:

Doch hierin lebt ein ewig Heute.

113. hold on] Pd: cling

114. To whatever... hold!] Pd: Whatever {will let} me cling
to

my happiness

(1876.)

Nicht mehr zurück? Und nicht hinan?

Auch für die Gemse keine Bahn?

OK

So wart'ich hier und fasse fest,

Was Aug' und Hand mich fassen läßt!

xk

Fünf Fuß breit Erde, Morgenroth,

Und unter mir – Welt, Mensch und – Tod!

{KSA/KGW failed to include the closing exclamation point.}

Heil dir, Freundschaft! Meiner höchsten Hoffnung Erste Mor-
genröthe! Ach, ohn' Ende

Schien oft Pfad und Nacht mir,

Alles Leben

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Ziellos und verhaft! Zweimal will ich leben,

Nun ich schaw' in deiner Augen

Morgenglanz und Sieg, Du liebste Göttin!

First guarantor Of my last hope Defiance and consolation Of
tired souls despairing Guarantee and prelude Of distant tri-
umph I want to live twice

To look twice into your eyes'

Morning splendor and midday peace

[Oh] Friendship! (N V 9, 14)

Hail to You, Friendship First guarantor Of my highest hope
Defiance and consolation [After] in starless nights,
When struggle and life [seemed] [meant] to me [to be in
vain]

[nothing] I want to live twice,

To look twice into your eyes'

Morning splendor, oh Goddess Friendship! Friendship! (N V 9,
13)

118. phrase] Wort {Wort can also be translated as "word." We
find "phrase" more appropriate to this context.}

Lebend'gem Worte bin ich gut: Das springt heran so wohlge-
muth, Das grüßt mit artigem Genick, Ist lieblich selbst im
Ungeschick,

Hat Blut in sich, kann herzhaft schnauben,
Kriecht dann zum Ohre selbst den Tauben,
618 NOTES TO PAGE 28

Und ringelt sich und flattert jetzt,
Und was es thut – das Wort ergetzt.
Doch bleibt das Wort ein zartes Wesen,
Bald krank und aber bald genesen.
Willst ihm sein kleines Leben lassen,
Mußt du es leicht und zierlich fassen,
Nicht plump betasten und bedrücken,
Es stirbt oft schon an bösen Blicken –
Und liegt dann da, so ungestalt,
So seelenlos, so arm und kalt,
Sein kleiner Leichnam arg verwandelt,
Von Tod und Sterben mißgehandelt.
Ein todttes Wort – ein häßlich Ding,
Ein klapperdürres Kling-Kling-Kling.
Pfui allen häßlichen Gewerben,
An denen Wort und Wörtchen sterben!
If you grasp at it with an icy glance
Then it quickly closes its eyes.
How can you then
With its little shadow-corpse
How can you bind word to word
I'm a friend of [the German] lively phrase
That jumps out at us with such good faith,
[That has its endearing clumsiness
Its hearty eye]
That greets us with an artful curt[skill]sy
Endearing even in its clumsiness
[And wants you... it]
[It has] Has blood within, [an eager creature]
can sniff heartily [eagerly] (N V 9, 180)
[And] Creeps |then| even into deaf ears
Yet it always will remain a [W] delicate creature,
[Quickly]

Soon sick and yet soon well
[And] if you |wish| to let it live its fleeting life:*

NOTES TO PAGE 28 619

Don't crudely grab and crush it,
It often dies merely from an evil [cold] eye.
[You may do that, you deformers,
With its little shadow-corpse]
[And lies then]
[And] there lies there then so [deformed] deformed,
So soulless, so poor and cold

Its little corpse [completely] terribly transformed,
brutalized through death and dying
[You] How ugly is a dead phrase]
You see it lying there and run away:
How ugly is a dead phrase!
Your grip [with hands] must be refined [and light] {Variant
to the
starred line above.}
(N V 9, 179)

And shame on every ugly business,
Through [which little animal-phrases die] [the phrase-
beasts]

Through which the friendly [P] animals die!
To bookbinders and day laborers
[The phrase, a marvelous beast
winged, small]

A dead phrase – an ugly thing
a bone-on-bony cling-cling-cling;
And cursed be the ugly business
[Through] [Through which friendly little animals]
Through which phrases and phrase lets die,
[through bookbinders and day laborers]
[That] They fight among themselves without renown
The little men those swine
And call it “style” and take pride in it
and now it curls up and flutters,
And what it does – the phrase delights, (N V 9, 178)

620 NOTES TO PAGES 28-36

123. women] Frauen

124. women] Frauen

125. {Cf. 2[46]; 3l1] 53; [a] .}

128. women] Frauen

129. women] Frauen

130. power] Kraft {We usually translate Kraft as “force,”
espe-

cially in passages related to his concept of drives, but
here “power”

seems to be a more suitable rendering.}

[2 =N V 9b.]

1. “On the occasion of Buddha’s prophecy about Metteyya,
the next Buddha, who will appear on the earth in the distant fu-

ture, it reads: “He will be the leader of a multitude of
hundreds of
thousands of disciples, just as I am now the leader of a
multitude

of hundreds (Cakkavattisihanada Sutta)." Hermann Oldenberg, Buddha: Sein Leben, seine Lehre, seine Gemeinde (Berlin{: Hertz,} 1897), 162n (the 1881 edition in NZ, 144n).

2. {Carl Gustav Carus, Vergleichende Psychologie oder Geschichte der Seele in der Reihenfolge der Tierwelt ("Comparative psychology or history of the soul in the hierarchy of the animal kingdom") (Vienna: Brownmiiller, 1866).}

Apparently copied out of a card catalogue.

Vogt] {Johann Gustav Vogt; cf. notebook 24, note 68.}

Lindau] {Paul Lindau}

. Wilbrandt] {Adolph von Wilbrandt}

(Cf. 7, 73]; 9[36].}

. Crossed out by N; cf. 3[1] 27.

. Cf. 3[1] 307; BGE 103.

10. And... blind.] |And| yet proclaim to me, you animals: Is [not] the sun already at its noon height? Is [not] the serpent [lin its light]] [called] eternity |called?| already coiling itself [, in its light?

Thus Zarathustra's hour had |already| come.] Zarathustra goes blind.

ur. Cf. si] 109; 12[1] 185.

YQ

yp PN AYA

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12. Cf. 3[1] 209. 13. Cf. 3[1] 210.

1s. Cf. 3[1] 200.

Sensuality rears its head like a dog that wants to have a bite of meat, even in the most cerebral interaction of the 2 sexes with each other. [MM: Similar thoughts in Lou Salomé's journals from this time: cf. Pfeiffer 208, 239.]

21. Cf. 5[1] rro. {The expanded context of 5[1] 110 indicates that N is talking about cats.}

Hebrews 12:6; cf. also Proverbs 13:24; Revelation 3:19.

27. Cf. 3[1] 188. 28. Cf. 3[1] 180. 29. Cf. 3[1] 187.]] [=]

30. Cf. 3[1] 178; ZI "On the Viper's Bite."

31. Cf. 3[r

34. necessary] {In this case N italicizes noth in nothwendige because it is a compound word, but there is no way to render this in English except by italicizing part of the word.}

36. {N is punning on the proverb Geteiltes Leid ist halbes Leid, i.e., "A problem shared is a problem halved."}

37. Refers to the following aphorisms: HAH 237, Renaissance and Reformation, D 88, Luther the great benefactor; JS 149, The failure of reformations.

622 NOTES TO PAGES 40-42

38. Cf. 3[1] 66; 12[1] 114; CW 15, 31[52]; 32[9]; Z IV "The Festival of the Ass."

40. to ultimate knowledge] zur letzten Erkenntnis

41. wall of knowledge] Zaun der Erkenntnis

43. it doesn't look so bad an ele(phant] es sieht da nicht übel aus
ein Ele(phant {This reflects the ungrammatical sentence in the original.}

47. Cf. 3[1] {64}: "It is not how... to be loved"; 3[1] 72; {22[3] 564}; BGE 79.
(3=ZI)

1. On the... eternity!" -] Cf. 111s]; 111or]; 3[4]. 3[4] is an earlier version; motto and title added later.

2. "Dorthin will ich! Und ich traue
"Mir fortan und meinem Griff.
"Offen ist das Meer, ins Blaue
"Treibt mein Genuesser Schiff.
"Alles wird mir neu und neuer,
"Weit hinaus glanzte Raum und Zeit -
"Heil dir, Schiff! Heil deinem Steuer!
"Um dich braust die Ewigkeit!" -

3. "Beyond. . . Sentences.] From: "Desay-uno" {"Breakfast"}/"Disillusionment." {These were possible alternative titles; die Ernüchterung ("Disillusionment") could also be translated as "Sobriety."}

4. "ilsait... plaisirs."] "Those who know how to enjoy life are

sensible sluggards brooding over their pleasures." {Cf. Guillaume
 Amfrye de Chaulieu, *Oeuvres de Chaulieu*, d'après les
 manuscrits
 de l'auteur: Tome premier (La Haye: Bleuët, 1774), 59-60. N
 might
 also have come across this line from the Duc de Nevers in an
 arti-
 cle by Amédée Renée, "Les nièces de Mazarin. Troisième
 partie:
 NOTES TO PAGES 42-45 623
 La Duchesse de Mercoeur, La Princesse de Conti, La Duchesse
 de
 Modène. – Le Duc de Nevers," in *Revue contemporaine*, Fourth
 year, Vol. 22 (Paris: Bureaux de la Revue Contemporaine,
 1855): 150.}

8. superior qualities] das Hohe
 9. base qualities] dessen Niedriges
 u. Cf. ZII "The Wanderer; {22[1]_ 561}.

22. their neighbors] ihre Nachsten {Not in the Christian or
 "neigh-
 borhood" sense, but rather "those to whom they are
 closest."}

27. Cf. 1[47]; BGE 86; first version: Behind all the feel-
 ings a
 man has for a woman there still lies contempt for the female
 sex.

28. superiority] Höhe

30. {Cf. 22[3]_562.}

32. poetically imagined] erdichten

624 NOTES TO PAGES 45-48

44. Cf. N to Heinrich von Stein, beginning December 1882
 {KGB III:1, 288}.

47. Cf. 12[1] 119; Z II "On Scholars"; "On Tarantulas";
 {9[48];
 12[42, 43]; 13[6]}.

48. We... explained.] First version: Something is often con-
 sidered to be absurd only because the conventional explana-
 tions
 for it are absurd: a deceptive work of art is the result. {N
 switches
 from passive voice in the first version to the singular uni-
 versal
 pronoun man in the final version, which we render here as
 "we."}

so. Cf. Z I "On Reading and Writing."

51. genius gravitationis] "spirit of gravity" or "demon of gravity"

54. brought to light] sich aufklart {N's wordplay is between sich aufklären ("brought to light") as a passive substitute and aufgeklärt sein ("enlightened").}

NOTES TO PAGES 48-51 625

65. Cf. 2[49]; N to Elisabeth N, Beginning of {9} September 1882 {KGB III:1, 252}.

67. {Cf. 22[3]_564.}

72. Those... enemy.] Pd: If people have never been against you, you will [never subjugate them] never become their ruler.

74. Cf. Vauvenargues: "Les grandes penseés viennent du coeur" {"Great thoughts come from the heart"}, quoted in Arthur Schopenhauer, *Parerga and Paralipomena*, vol. 2, trans. Adrian Del Caro and Christopher Janaway (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2015), 12; cf. 22[3]{_563}; CW 18, 20[29].

78. Cf. 2[41]; 12[1] 114; CW 15, 31[52]; 32[9]; Z IV "The Festival of the Ass."

83. by means of truthfulness] über seine Wahrhaftigkeit Humans" 7.

87. Cf. 12[1] 112; ZI "On the Viper's Bite." N crossed out this first version: Behind every person who judges stands the executioner.

88. First version: When we are sublimely above good and evil, we see all tragedies as unintended comedies and are far from granting tragic natures the greatest significance. III:1, 259}.

go. Cf. 22[3]{_565}; BGE 180.

626 NOTES TO PAGES 51-55

93. Cf. 3[1] 149; ZI "On the Flies of the Marketplace." First version: Cowardice in the face of a neighbor is a basic character trait of very loveable people.

94. grab... neck] am Schöpfe fassen

100. an appendage] From: the embodiment

101. as an appendage . . . action] als Zubehör einer einzigen Tat

102. a chalk line drawn around a hen] der Kreidestreich um die
Henne {Refers to a trick used by hypnotists, whereby a hen would
refuse to step across a chalk line, even though it was capable of
doing so.}

105. First version: A. "What you are teaching here is not yet
your philosophy!" B. Why not? A. "If it were yours |my friend,|
you would (1) demand nothing more except to dance – at least once a day. (2) walk differently: you should be seen dancing at
(least) once a day! Dancing is the proof [since] of truth for me,
the proof of force." Later version: Our stride reveals whether we
have found our path. Cf. ZIV "On Superior Humans" 17.

109. "One person... around") "Einer ist doch noch zuviel um mich" {A play on the proverb Drei sind einer zu viel, or "Two's
company, three's a crowd."}
uo. Cf. ZI "On Friends."
ur. Cf. BGE 174.

114. to each my own] jedem das Meine {A play on the saying jedem das Seine, or "to each his own."}

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115.
116.
117. 118.
Cf. BGE 65a.
Cf. 5[17]; 12[1] 111; ZI "On the Flies of the Marketplace."
Cf. si] 2093 12[1s]; 13[15].
Pd: We believe in things that do not exist e.g., selflessness, always at the cost of things that exist, e.g., selfishness.

120. Cf. ZI "On Little Women, Old and Young." {Cf. 4[38]; sli] 73b.}

I.
122.
123.
124.
125.
126.
127. 128.

Cf. 4[104]; 5[1] 166; ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 4.
 Cf. CW, 31[52]; 32[8]; BGE 65.
 Cf. BGE 64.
 All women] "Alle Frauen
 'All women... one.] Cf. ZI "On Friends."
 Cf. BGE 152.
 Cf. Z I "On Reading and Writing."
 Cf. Z II "On Compassionate People"; {12[1] 107; 13[8]}.
 {English speakers feel pangs of conscience, Germans "bites"
 of
 conscience, so the pun on GewissensbisselBeifen is lost
 here.}
 130.
 The . . . animals.] Cf. 12[1] 110; Z II "On Compassionate
 People."
 132. 133. Cf. 12[1] 108; BGE 170.
 First version: with some decent will to live – there is lit-
 tle suffering on account of the "Will to Live."
 135. 136. 137. 138. 139. 140. 141. 142. 143.
 Cf. slr] 167; BGE 151.
 Cf. 3[1] 85; ZI "On the Flies of the Marketplace."
 Cf. BGE 63.
 Cf. ZI "On Friends."
 Cf. ZI "On the Virtue of Gift-Giving" 3.
 Cf. ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 9.
 Cf. Z I "On Reading and Writing."
 Cf. BGE 156.
 First version: Nothing is more pathetic than to see good
 people straining to prove that superior h(uman beings) were
 cre-
 ated in the image of their god.
 628
 145.
 146.
 Cf. ZI "On Reading and Writing."
 Cf. 5[33].
 {Pluralization was not possible here because of the discus-
 sion of two individuals.}
 149.
 150.
 Cf. Z I "On Reading and Writing."
 and... will stink] and morality is removed from the world,
 namely, talked to death
 152. 153. 154. 155. 156. 157.
 Cf. 12[1] 106; 13[8]; Z II "On Tarantulas."
 Cf. ZI "On Reading and Writing."

Cf. ZI "On Reading and Writing."
 Cf. ZI "On Reading and Writing."
 Cf. BGE 157.
 Cf. ZI "On the Way of Those Who Create." First version:
 Every sensation that doesn't kill us is killed by us.
 159. 160. 161. 162. 163. 164.
 Cf. 2[35].
 Cf. ZI "On the Viper's Bite"; {2[33]}.
 Cf. 2[34]; ZI "On the Viper's Bite."
 Cf. 2[31].
 women] Frauen
 three-eyed] dreiäugig {A metaphor of supernatural vision
 or insight from the iconography of Zeus in Greek mythology.}
 166. 167. 168. 169. 170. 171.
 Cf. ZI "On the Pale Criminal."
 Cf. BGE 159.
 Cf. ZI "On the Viper's Bite."
 Cf. 2[32]; ZI "On Love of One's Neighbor."
 Cf. 2[30].
 Cf. 2[28]; 5[17]; ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 4; paraphrase
 of Hebrews 12:6; cf. also Proverbs 13:24; Revelation 3:19.
 173. 174. Cf. 2[22]; ZI "On Chastity." Cf. 2[27]; BGE 161.
 NOTES TO PAGES 63-68 629
 177. 178.
 179. 180.
 181. 182. 183.
 Cf. 2[21].
 Cf. 2[20]; ZI "On War and Warrior Peoples."
 Cf. 2[19].
 Cf. 2[18]; Z I "On Friends."
 Cf. 2[16]; ZI "On Little Women, Old and Young."
 Cf. 2[17].
 Cf. 12[1] 104; BGE 162. {The wordplay here is between
 Nachster, the biblical designation for a fellow human being,
 and
 Nachbar, someone living in close proximity; both are trans-
 lated
 by "neighbor."}
 185. 186. 187. 188. 189.
 190.
 191. 192. 193. 194.
 Cf. BGE 100.
 Cf. 12[1] 105; Z II "On Compassionate People."
 Cf. ZI "On Loving Thy Neighbor."
 Cf. 2 [13].
 Cf. 2[14].

Cf. 4[96]; 5[17]; ZI "On the Viper's Bite."
 Cf. 2[38]; ZI "On the Viper's Bite."
 Cf. BGE 67.
 Cf. CW, 31[53]; 3219]; Z IV "On Superior Humans" 9.
 Cf. ZI "On Chastity."
 196. females] Weibchen {With no attributive to provide the
 pejor-
 ative nuance implied by the diminutive, we chose what some
 regard
 as a pejorative form in American usage.}
 197. 198. 199.
 200.
 201.
 202. 203. 204. 205. 206. 207.
 Cf. 2[29].
 Cf. 1[24]; ZI "On the Way of Those Who Create."
 Cf. 1[25]; si] 59.
 Cf. 118]; {1[9]; 3[1] 34]; 2213]_563; JS 262}.
 Cf. 1[38]; 25[171].
 Cf. 1[40]; BGE 66.
 Cf. CW 15, 31[53]; 32[9]; BGE 69.
 Cf. CW, 31[53]; 32[9]; Z IV "On Superior Humans."
 Cf. 12[1] 151; Z II "The Prophet."
 Cf. ZI "On War and Warrior Peoples."
 Cf. BGE 68.
 630 NOTES TO PAGES 69-72
 BGE 99.
 213. {Cf. 4[165]; 5[2]; 1118]; 18[43, 49, 56]; 21[6];
 24[16].}
 214. aside from the ten thousand people who have superior
 spir-
 its.] abseits von dem oberen Zehntausend des Geistes, cf. GM
 II 7.
 218. feeling] Empfindung {We translate this as "feeling"
 when
 N doesn't mean sensation or perception. Elsewhere we also
 use
 "feeling" to translate Gefühl.}
 221. the stars... "above you,"] {This is an allusion to
 Kant's
 famous conclusion to the Critique of Practical Reason that
 is now
 inscribed on his tombstone: "Zwei Dinge erfiillen das Gemiit
 mit
 immer neuer und zunehmender Bewunderung und Erhfurcht, je
 öfter und anhaltender sich das Nachdenken damit beschäftigt:

der bestirnte Himmel über mir, und das moralische Gesetz in mir."

("Two things fill the mind with ever new and increasing admiration and reverence, the more often and more steadily one reflects on them: the starry heavens above me and the moral law within me")

(Immanuel Kant, Critique of Practical Reason, rev. ed., trans. Mary Gregor [Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2015], 129.)).

Superior Humans."

NOTES TO PAGES 72-79 631

231. 232. 233.

234.

235.

236.

intellect] Geist {Which can also mean "spirit."}

Cf. BGE 77.

Cf. Z I "On the Viper's Bite."

Cf. BGE 78.

Cf. 1[26].

Cf. 4[200]; 4[42]; 12[1] 96; 13[19]; Z IV "No Longer in Service"; Z II "On Compassionate People."

238. 239.

240.

241.

242.

243.

244.

245.

246.

Cf. ZI "On Reading and Writing."

Cf. Z I "On Reading and Writing."

Cf. BGE 95.

Cf. 12[1] 146; 13[14]; Z III "On Unchosen Bliss."

Cf. ZI "On the Tree on the Mountainside."

Cf. ZI "On Loving Thy Neighbor."

Cf. ZI "On Little Women, Old and Young"; {cf. 4[161]}.

Cf. Z I "On Reading and Writing."

humans] Menschen {N juxtaposes humans with women in this passage.}

248. 249.

250.

Cf. ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 4.

Cf. BGE 94; {cf. 4[13]; s[1] 113}.
 "Ella guardava suso, ed io in lei"] "She looked upward, and I at her"; cf. Divina Commedia, Paradiso II, 22: "Beatrice in suso, ed io in lei guardava" ("Beatrice looked upward, and I at her").
 252. 253. 254. 255. 256. 257. 258.
 compulsion] Trieb {Which we usually translate as "drive."}
 Cf. 4[42].
 Cf. BGE 173.
 Cf. BGE 172.
 {Cf. Matthew 18:3.}
 Cf. BGE 96.
 Cf. 12[1] 148; 13[14]; 16[7]; Z IV "On Superior Humans"
 u. {We translate der Nächste (neighbor or fellow human being in the Christian sense) as "neighbor" and in this case pluralize it to preserve gender neutrality.}
 632
 Cf. BGE 98. {Germans speak of the "bites of conscience" (Gewissensbisse); cf. note 129 above.}
 263. 264. 265. 266. 267. 268. 269. 270.
 271.
 272. 273. 274.
 275.
 276. 277. 278. 279. 280.
 281.
 282.
 283.
 284.
 285.
 286. 287.
 Cf. 12[1] 95.
 Cf. BGE 182.
 Cf. 5[35].
 Cf. 5[35]3 12[1] 53; 13[12]; Z II "On Compassionate People."
 Cf. 12[1] 945 5135].
 Cf. 5[35].
 Cf. 5 [35]; ZI "On Matters of Joy and Passion."
 Cf. 5[35, 33]; 12[1] 142; BGE 183.
 Cf. 5[33].
 Cf. 12[1] 90; 13[16]; 16[7]; BGE 169.
 Cf. 5[33].
 Cf. 5[35].
 women] Frauen

Women... as such.) CF. 1[50]; 12[1] 92.
 I... persons.] Cf. Z I "On Friends."
 Cf. ZI "On Freely-Chosen Death."
 Cf. BGE 104.
 Cf. 12[1] 91; Z II "On Virtuous People."
 Cf. D 275.
 Cf. BGE 97.
 Cf. BGE 185.
 N skips over number 363 in his notebook.
 Cf. ZI "On War and Warrior-Peoples."
 Cf. ZI "On Little Women, Old and Young."
 Cf. 4[95, 110]; 5[1] 29; ZI "On Chastity." {We render er as
 "he" because it is a reference to Zarathustra.}
 289. Cf. BGE 107.
 291. general feelings] Gemeingefühle {The term gemein has
 two
 «
 meanings, one of which is "general" or "shared in common,"
 the
 other "base." N might have either of these in mind because
 mo-
 rality refers to a shared phenomenon but also to base feel-
 ings like
 resentment.}
 NOTES TO PAGES 84-90 633
 292.
 Cf. BGE 109; ZI "On the Pale Criminal."
 294. pia fraus] "pious fraud" {In the Catholic dogma of the
 "pious
 fraud," Jesus is presented as the bait on the hook of the
 cross with
 which Leviathan (the demon of the deep, i.e., the devil) is
 taken and
 made to render up the souls he has seized.}
 295. 296. 297. 298. 299.
 301.
 impia fraus] "impious fraud"
 Cf. BGE tos.
 sancta simplicitas] "holy simplicity"
 Cf. ZI "On the Way of Those Who Create."
 Cf. ZI "On the Pale Criminal."
 .. him] Cf. BG E 113.
 {See the Translators' Afterword, 748-93, for our arguments
 in favor of translating Übermensch as "superhumans."}
 302. 303. 304. 305. 306. 307. 308. 309.
 310. 311. Cf. 12[1] 179.

Cf. 12[1] 109; BOE 88.
 Cf. BGE 112; {12[1] 89; 13[8]}.
 Cf. sl] 127; BGE 184, 111.
 Cf. 12[1] 180; Z II "On Compassionate People."
 Cf. ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 3.
 Cf. 12[1] 87
 Cf. BGE 171.
 Cf. 12[1] 181.
 Cf. Z I "On Chastity"; {cf. Matthew 8:31, Mark 5:12, and
 Luke 8:32}.
 313. 314. 315.
 316. 317. 318.
 Cf. 12[1] 149.
 Cf. BGE 123.
 Cf. BGE 168.
 Cf. BGE 167.
 Cf. BGE 122.
 with our mouths and faces] mit Munde und Maule {N is
 playing off the idiom ein Maul machen, "to pout."}
 320. 321.
 Cf. BGE 120.
 Cf. ZI "On War and Warrior-Peoples."
 634 NOTES TO PAGES 90-92
 331. IfGod... love.] Cf. 22[3]{_568}. {We preserve N's word-
 play on the "bites of conscience"; cf. note 129 above.}
 337. those who darn its socks] Strumpfwirker {Strumpfwirker
 were
 weavers of socks, the bottom caste of what was considered to
 be
 one of the lower professions.}
 339. There are... manly.] Cf. Z III "On the Virtue That Di-
 minishes"; {cf. 22[3]_568}.
 341. This thinker... red hot.] Cf. 3[1] 11; BGE 91; {1[64];
 4[29];
 sl] 67}.
 Hoch wuchs ich iiber Mensch und Thier;
 Und sprech ich – Niemand spricht mit mir.
 OK
 Zu einsam wuchs ich und zu hoch:
 Ich warte: warauf wart' ich doch?
 OK
 Zu nah ist mir der Wolken Sitz,–
 Ich warte auf den ersten Blitz.
 OK
 NOTES TO PAGES 93–97 635
 On to New Seas.

Freundin – sprach Columbus – traue
Keinem Genuesen mehr!

Immer start er in das Blaue,
Fernstes zieht ihn allzusehr!

xk

Wen er liebt, den lockt erg erne
Weit hinaus aus Raum und Zeit – –
Über uns glänzt Stern bei Sterne,
Um uns braust die Ewigkeit. xx

[4=N Voc. N VI 1b. NV 8.]

1. {Cf. N to Heinrich von Stein, beginning December 1882,
KGB III:7/1, 312.}

3 [1] 92.}

4. {Cf 30] 4385 si] 94-}

s. {Cf. 4138]; si) 72.}

6. {Cf. s[1] 96.}

9. god-humans] Gottmensch {We use this rendering when N
refers to polytheistic systems; we use “God-made-human” when
N uses Gottmensch to refer to Jesus.}

u. Cf. 4[13).

13. bustle] Lärm (“noise”)

14. {Cf. Hermann Oldenberg, Buddha: Sein Leben, seine Lehre,
seine Gemeinde (Berlin: Hertz, 1881), 375, NL; translated by
Wil-

liam Hoey as Buddha: His Life, His Doctrine, His Order (Lon-
don:

Williams and Norgate, 1882): 367.}

15. {Cf. 4[9].}

16. {Cf. 3[1] 313; si] 113; BGE 94.}

636 NOTES TO PAGES 97-102

19. woman] Frau

20. lam... go away.] Like Socrates; cf. Plato, Phaedo Goa.

22. love me(a)ls] Liebesma(h)le {A reference to the Euchar-
ist

and perhaps to Wagner’s opera Das Liebesmahl der Apostel
(1843) .}

23. {Cf. 4[32, 115, 249]; sft] 175.}

25. Cf. 4[22, 204, 213]; 5[32]; ZI “Zarathustra’s Preface”
5; “On

a Thousand and One Goals.”

27. tool] Mittel {The standard translation is “means,” but
“tool”

captures it better in this context.}

28. superhumans] {One of the few times N uses the term
Übermenschen in the plural; see also 4[254], 5[32], 10[37,
41], and

13[26].}
Peoples.”
37. creative] Schaffende {Usually translated as “those who create.”}
38. Cf. 3[1] 21; ZI “On the Flies of the Marketplace”; 5[1] 87,
86, 88; BGE 119.
39. Cf. slt] 69, 70, 71, 72, 73, 75, 78, 76, 74, 73, 773 Si] 95; 3l1)
128; ZI “On War and Warrior-Peoples”; “On Little Women, Old and Young.”
40. blessed? Be blessed] selig werde? Sei selig {The standard English translation of selig werden is “to be saved” or “to find salvation,”
whereas the standard English translation of selig sein, as in the Beatitudes, is “Blessed is/are...” We translate selig as “blessed” in both clauses to preserve the wordplay; cf. Matthew 19:16.}
NOTES TO PAGES IO–III 637
41.
42.
43.
44.
45.
46.
47.
48.
49. 50. 51. 52. 53-
{Cf. 4l]s si] 72.}
{Cf. 3[1] 128; 5[1] 73b.}
Cf. 1[83]; CW 13, 11[195].
Cf. 5[1] 85, 84, 83, 82, 81, 80, 79.
{Cf. si] 83; 12[1] 195.}
Cf. s[1] 122, 121.
{Cf. 3[1] 68.}
ancient] alt
{Cf. 3[1] 287; 4[200]; 12[1] 96; 13[19].}
{Cf. 3[1] 317}
Cf. BGE 143; sl1] 48, 47; {3[1] 19}.
{Cf. 3[1] 18.}
abolish] aufheben {N could also have a Hegelian term in mind here, in which case “supersede” might be a more natural translation.}
54.

ignorance] Unkenntnis {As opposed to the standard term Unwissen.}

S. 56.

\$7. 58.

{Cf. 2[43]; 3l1] 65; 22[3]_564.}

{Cf. 3[1] 51, 60; 1[34, 79, 80]; 4[44]; sl] 46; 12[1] 200.}

Cf. 3[1] 109.

distress] Noth {N could also have "hardship," "adversity," " . » « ys .

misery, or "want" in mind.}

60.

61.

62. 63. 64.

65.

escort] Geleit {N omits the verb here.}

Cf. 4[139, 75]; ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 3.

Cf. 4[169].

Cf. 12[1] 124.

Cf. 12[1] 127, 126.

{François duc de La Rochefoucauld, De la Rochefoucault's Sätze aus der höhern Welt- und Menschenkunde ("De la Rochefoucauld's phrases from the study of the higher world and human beings"), trans. from the French by Friedrich Schulz (Breslau: Wilhelm Gottlieb Korn, 1793), 77. NL. De la Rochefoucauld's Maximen und Reflexionen, trans. from the French by Friedrich Hörlek (Leipzig: Philipp Reclam, 1875), 26, nr. 183. NL.}

66. 67. Cf. 12[1] 130, 131. Cf. 12[1] 139.

638 NOTES TO PAGES III-II

70. utile... dulce] utile = useful; dulce = sweet {Cf. Horace, Ars poetica, lines 343-44: Omne tulit punctum qui miscuit utile dulci, lectorem delectando pariterque monendo. ("He wins every hand who mingles the useful with sweet, by delighting and instructing the reader at the same time.") These lines are annotated by N in his copy of Des Q. Horatius Flaccus Sämmtliche Werke. Zweiter Theil: Satiren und Episteln; Für den Schulgebrauch, ed. Georg Theodor August Kriiger (Leipzig: B. G. Teubner, 1853).}

71. sit tibi terra levis] "May the earth rest lightly on

you" {A
 benediction for the dead, often inscribed on tombstones or
 other
 gravestones, and commonly abbreviated STTL.}
 73. mosquitoes] Mücken {The "bloodsucking" context here
 indi-
 cates that N probably had mosquitoes (Culicidae) rather than
 gnats
 (Nematocera) in mind. Our nineteenth-century desk encyclope-
 dia
 also attributes a bloodsucking function to Mücken. The
 strictness
 of the distinction Mückenl Stechmücken also varies region-
 ally}
 75. just... avenged] {This loses N's pun on gerecht ("just")
 and
 gerächt ("avenged").}
 78. {Cf. 5[33].}
 81. drives me crazy] zum Aus-der-Haut fahren
 83. I don't... a meal.] {This is a play on the German ex-
 pres-
 sion der Appetit kommt beim Essen ("appetite comes with eat-
 ing"),
 itself derived from Rabelais's "L'appétit vient en man-
 geant."}
 84. {Cf. si] 24 12[1] 156.}
 85. darkness... well."] {A reference to the German proverb
 Im
 Dunkeln ist gut munkeln = "Darkness is good for whispering";
 cf.
 si] 26.}
 NOTES TO PAGES I-123 639
 87. honorable men] Biedermann {The term Biedermann was
 translated in N's time as man of honor, man of worth,
 gentle-
 man, or worthy, and had not yet acquired the exclusively pe-
 jora-
 tive connotations that modern German has of a limited, prov-
 in-
 cial outlook.}
 88. until fame arrives] zum Leuchten kommen {literally, un-
 til
 [one] becomes illustrious or famous}.
 90. brakes] Hemmschuh {Hemmschuh refers to a shoe-like
 device
 applied to the outside of the wheel of a carriage or other

vehicle to
 provide braking ability.}
 92. {Cf. 4[83].}
 97. {Cf. 4[67].}
 100. primum vivere] "first live"
 101. Cf. 4[75].
 103. mom] Miitterchen
 108. bon gout] "good taste"
 109. Cf. 5[1] 158, 157.
 11. reason] (die) Vernunft {The definite article die appears
 in
 brackets in the original German and is not translated in the
 English
 equivalent.}
 13. {Cf. si] 155; 22[5]_572.}
 640 NOTES TO PAGES 123-131
 115. Cf. 5[1] 161, 162.
 116. {Cf. [1] 153.}
 117. {Cf. 5[33].}
 120. {Cf. 3i] 368; 4[110]; si] 29.}
 121. "Virtue of Gift-Giving."
 123. {Cf. 4[210, 228]; 5[7, 17].}
 124. At least... eclipsed in time.] Dafür versinkt ihr nicht
 ganz
 in der Zeit.
 126. {Cf. 3[1] 130; sl] 166.}
 127. {Cf. 3[1] 272.}
 129. {Cf. 3[1] 368; 4[95]; sii] 29.}
 130. "Freethinking"] "Freigeist" {The context of this word
 indi-
 cates intellectual and cognitive, not affective, improve-
 ment, thus
 pointing to "freethinking" rather than "free spirit."}
 133. {Cf. s[1] 176; {5[17]; 16[9]; 22[3]_563}.
 138. Moldenhauer] {E. F. Theodor Moldenhauer, nineteenth-
 century German astronomer and cosmologist, author of Die
 Axendrehung der Weltkörper: Beitrag zur Lösung einer natur-
 wis-
 senschaftlichen Frage ("The axial rotation of the world
 body: Con-
 tribution to solving a scientific question") (Berlin: Weber,
 1871),
 and Das Weltall und seine Entwicklung: Darlegung der
 neuesten
 Ergebnisse der kosmologischen Forschung ("The universe and
 its

evolution: Presentation of the latest results of cosmological research") (Cologne: Mayer, 1882).}

NOTES TO PAGES 131-138 641

139. Mainländer] {Philip Mainländer (1841-76), German poet and philosopher. N was familiar with his central philosophical

work, *Die Philosophie der Erlösung* ("The philosophy of redemption"). NL.}

141. {Cf. 4[145].}

142. in-and-for-itself] An-und-für-sich {Although this has become

a standard phrase in German, its origin is Hegelian and N no doubt

recognizes this.}

145. heal, savior] {In German, "heal" (heilen) and "savior" (Heiland) are cognate.}

148. primum mobile] "first moved" {The primum mobile in Ptolemaic astronomy was the outermost sphere of the heavens, which was the first mover of the universe. It is also associated

with Aristotle's "prime mover," as in 4[138].}.

150. {Cf. 4[49].}

151. Cf. sit] 181, 1825 {sl1] 7}.

152. moralis] {Cf. Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A New Latin Dictionary* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1879): of or belonging to manners or morals, moral (a word formed by Cicero).

"Illness" is underlined by N, "moralis" is not.}

155. {Cf. 4[122].}

156. ends] Zweck {N is playing off the distinction between means and ends in this fragment, so we translate Zweck here as

"end" rather than "purpose."}

157. codes of goodness] Gütertafel

159. peach] Apfel ("apple") {Apfel is translated here as "peach,"

since in N's time it could refer to any kind of juicy fruit. See

Grimm 1:532-43.}

642 NOTES TO PAGES 138-145

160. sensibility] Gemüth {See the Translators' Afterword, 743-

44, for how we translate Gemiith}
 162. most intellectual] die Geistigsten {Another possibility is
 "most spiritual"; we chose "most intellectual" because the
 pre-
 ceding fragment is concerned with reason.}
 165. this timelessness] dies ohne Zeit
 166. everything . . . straight] {Cf. Isaiah 45:2; Luke 3:5.}
 167. {Cf. 3[1] 303.}
 169. {Cf. 3[1] 245; 11[8]; 18[43, 49, 56]; 21[6]; 24[16].}
 170. laugh and weep] {An allusion to Franz Schubert's song
 "Lachen und Weinen" ("Laughter and Weeping"), composed in
 1822, D. 777 in Otto Erich Deutsch's catalogue.}
 172. {Cf. als₁}.
 174. one] {As we explain in the Afterword, the singular
 refer-
 ence to what has been created refers to a single category or
 species
 that includes a plurality of instances or members; see
 732-34.}
 177. golden ee {Cf. Ecclesiastes 12:6.}
 180. {Cf. si] 254; 5[22]; 12[5]; 13[7]; 16[7].}
 181. Cf. *šii*] 255.
]]] I
 186. {Cf. s[1] 158.}
 188. charcoal burners] Kohlenbrenner {Charcoal burning was
 known for being a low-paying, dirty, dangerous profession.
 Burners
 [[183. Cf. sl [[]
 NOTES TO PAGES 145-153 643
 were forced to travel constantly to gain employment. The
 joke here
 is that the Church is approaching people who experience hell
 on
 earth with threats about the hell to come.}
 191. shoo-fly] Fliegenwedel {A device associated with horse-
 back
 riding; could be attached to saddle or harness.}
 193. Cf. si] 263, 264; {12[1] 199; KSA mistakenly notes
 frag-
 ment 4[198]}.
 194. {Cf. 3[1] 287; 4[42]; 12[1] 96; 13[19].}
 196. coincidence] Zufall {The standard rendering, "chance,"
 does not work here.}
 197. {Cf. 4[20, 22].}
 198. minds] Geister {In this context, this could also be

"spirits."}
 199. a little old lady] das alte Weibchen {N does not mean
 any
 particular "little old lady," hence the change to the indef-
 inite
 article.}
 200. rattle... drum] {In English, drums roll; in German,
 they
 rattle.}
 Uebermenschen {Here N means the subject to be taught, not the
 audience. See 5[8] and 16[89], where "superhumans" are also
 the
 subject matter.}
 205. {Cf. 4[100, 228]; 5[7, 17].}
 211. {Cf. 5[18].}
 213. {Cf. 1[59]; 30] 13; 12[1] 147; 13[14]; 16[7].}
 644
 214.
 215. 216. 217. 218. 219.
 220.
 221.
 Cf. 5[7, 17].
 bring] richtet {The verb is singular, the subject plural
 here.}
 {Cf. 4[100, 210].}
 Cf. 5[13, 16, 17, 20, 32].
 ingenuity] Geist
 {Cf. 3[1] 182.}
 {Cf. 4[266]; 5[14, 32].}
 Cf. si] 260.
 out of... into the fire] aus dem Regen... unter die Traufe
 {The German equivalent of "out of the frying pan into the
 fire" is
 literally "out of the rain into the drainpipe."}
 223.
 224.
 225.
 226.
 Cf. ZI "On the Viper's Bite."
 Cf. ZI "On Despisers of the Body."
 Cf. ZI "On the Three Transformations."
 {they}] {The antecedent of "they" in the phrase "If they
 did" in the following sentence is missing in the German.}
 228. 229. 230. 231.
 Cf. {4[17, 32, 115);} sl] 175.
 Cf. ZI "On Professorships of Virtue."

Cf. 5 [32].

lock, stock and barrel] Kost und Küche {An obscure locution. Grimm 11:1847 cites Kost und Kleidung as analogous in English to

"room and board."}

233. 234. 235.

236. 237. 238.

239.

after this position] nach dieser Seite

Cf. ZI "On the Virtue of Gift-Giving."

Cf. 5[16, 20].

{Cf. 41230}; s[r].}

noxious] böse {Here adapted to the herbal metaphor.}

Cf. 5[32].

knowing one] die Wissenden {As opposed to die Erkennenden ("the ones who know").}

240.

The belly of existence] Der Bauch des Seins

242. good] Nutzen {Translated as "good" here in the context of

utilitarianism.}

NOTES TO PAGES 166-170 645

[5 =Z I 2a. Mp XV 3a.]

L Collection of sayings from the early manuscripts (especially

N V, N VI, N V 8); numbered by N.

5. consumption] Schwind sucht {The term in N's time for consumption (tuberculosis).}

1u. Cf. 1211] 141.

1s. Cf. 4[72]; 12[1] 56; BGE 18.

17. darkness... well."] {A reference to the German proverb Im

Dunkeln ist gut munkeln = "Darkness is good for whispering"; cf.

41].}

24. "Honorable men"] "Biedermännerei" {Biedermann or "honorable man" was an ideal in Nietzsche's time. By using the pejorative

suffix -erei, he is saying that anyone who lives up to this

ideal is contemptible.}

646

30.

31. 32. 33.

34.

35.

36.
 37. 38.
 39. 40. 41. 42. 43. 44.
 45.
 46.
 47.
 48.
 {Cf. 4[62].}
 {Cf. 4[62].}
 {Cf. 4[62].}
 Cf. 1[ss].
 Cf. 4[44]; ZI "On the Way of Those Who Create."
 Cf. 4[44]; 12[1] 200; {cf. 3[1] 51, 60}.
 Cf. 4[43].
 {Cf. 4[43].}
 Cf. ZI "On Friends."
 Cf. 1[43, 78].
 Cf. 12[1] 182.
 Cf. 4[26]; BGE 116.
 Cf. 3i] 73; {2[42]}.
 Cf. BGE 117.
 Cf. 125]; 301] 223.
 Cf. 1[5]; 12[1] 184.
 Cf. 1[67, 70, 88]; {1[73, 108]}.
 Cf. 1[87]; 1[108]4; 12[1] 194; BGE 114.
 Cf. 1[86]; 1[108] 2.
 "Perish . . . ocean!"] Gehe unter in diesem Meer {Untergehen
 has the literal sense here of disappearing under the waves.}
 50.
 SI.
 52. 53- 54. 55-
 CE 1[72].
 temperaments] Naturen
 Cf. 1[70].
 Cf. 4[29]; {1[64]; 31 11; 3l1] 445; 4129]; BGE 91}.
 Cf. 1[62].
 become blessed . . . be blessed] selig werde . . sei selig
 {The
 standard English tr  hsl  rion of selig werden is "to be
 saved" or "to
 find salvation," whereas the standard English translation of
 selig
 sein, as in the Beatitudes, is "Blessed is/are . . . " We
 translate selig
 as "blessed" in both clauses to preserve the wordplay. Cf.
 Mat-

thew 19:16.}

57. Cf. sii] 95, 4[38]; cf. N to Heinrich von Stein, early Decem-

ber 1882 {KGB III:1, 287}.

NOTES TO PAGES 174-177 647

60. Cf. 4[38].

61. Everything... pregnancy.] Cf. ZI "On Little Women, Old and Young"; cf. 3[1] 128; 4[38].

63. Cf. 4[38]. 64. Cf. 4[38]. 65. Cf. 4[38].

68. Cf. Z I "On War and Warrior-Peoples."

77. Cf. 4[34]; Z I "On War and Warrior-Peoples."

];

82. Cf. 4[4]; Z I "On War and Warrior-Peoples."

83. Cf. note to sl1] 70.

4

90. Cf. 4[6]; ZI "On Matters of Joy and Passion."

648

NOTES TO PAGES 177-II

100. your] sein {The context indicates that this probably refers

back to "you."}

IOI.

102. 103. 104. 105. 106. . Cf. 4l].

. Cf. 4[77]; 12[1] 197.

. Cf. 4[49, 75]; ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 3.

. Cf. 301] 95; BGE 184.

. Cf. 4[76].

. Cf. 4[76]; ZI "On Preachers of Death."

Cf. al1s, 77]; ZI "On Little Women, Old and Young."

Cf. 4[18]; ZI "On Little Women, Old and Young."

Cf. 4[28].

{Cf 4[27].}

Cf. 4[41].

Cf. 4[76].

Cf. 4[87]; 12[1] 198; Z II "The stillest Hour."

Cf. 4[82]; s[1] 142.

Cf. 4[78].

Cf. 4177).

Cf. 4[77]. Cf. 4[77].

. The point must be reached] So weit soll es kommen

SCH 415 771:

. Cf. 4[78].

123.

Cf. 4[78]; ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 3.

Cf. 4[86]; Z I "On Matters of Joy and Passion"; "On the Tree on the Mountainside."

126.
 127.
 128. 129.
 Cf. 4[78, 84].
 Cf. 4[84].
 Cf. 4[79].
 Cf. Z I "On Little Women, Old and Young."
 NOTES TO PAGES 181-184 649
 131.
 132.
 133.
 134.
 135. 136. 137. 138. 139.
 140.
 141.
 142.
 145.
 146.
 147.
 148. 149.
 150. 151.
 152. 153. 154. 155.
 156. 157. 158. 159.
 160.
 161. 162.
 Cf. 4[88].
 Cf. 4[89].
 Cf. 4[93]; ZI "On the Viper's Bite"; {4[104]}.
 Cf. 4[93].
 Cf. 4[92].
 Cf. 4[92]; 5[33]; ZI "On the Viper's Bite."
 Cf. 4[91].
 Cf. 4[11]; 5[33].
 Cf. 4[90].
 Cf. 4[90, 186].
 Cf. 4[88].
 Cf. 4[76]; {4[85]; cf. Heraclitus, Diels-Kranz fragment
 "It is not possible to step twice into the same river"}.
 Cf. ZI "On the Three Transformations"; 4[92, 96, 112].
 Cf. 4[94].
 Cf. 4[r].
 Cf. 3[1] 130; 4[104]; ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 4.
 Cf. 3[1] 146; BGE 151.
 Cf. a ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 3.
 CF. aal sliz): {16[9 i ab ae
 {Cf. 4[113].}

Cf. ZI "On the Three Transformations."
 Cf. 4[144].
 Cf. 4l].
 moral drives] sittlichen Triebe {N uses sittlich to refer to
 the morality of customs; see GM II. Cf. 4[142].}
 164.
 165.
 Cf. 4[142]. {Cf 4[135].}
 650
 166. 167. 168. 169.
 172. 173. 174.
 175.
 {Cf. 4[136].}
 Cf. ZI "On the Pale Criminal."
 Cf. ZI "On the Pale Criminal."
 {Cf. 4[117].}
 Cf. 4[148] {and note to 5[1] 170}; 12[20].
 Cf. 12[21].
 Cf. ZI "On Preachers of Death."
 Cf. 5[19, 30]; ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 3.
 Cf. 12[18].
 Cf. ZI "On Preachers of Death."
 knowledge] das Wissen
 177. you... dozing.] Cf. ZI "On the Pale Criminal."
 178.
 179. 180.
 181. 182. 183.
 184.
 185.
 186. 187. Cf. 4[148 188. Cf. 3[1]124; 12[15]; 13[t]. Cf.
 12[13].
 Cf. 12[14]; {s[1] 214; 10[17]; 1201] 171; 12 [13];
 13[1]_375}-
 knowing . . . being known] Wissen und Erkenntsein
 Cf. 12[13, 14]; {5[1] 213; 10[17]; 12[1] 171; 13[1]_375}-
 Cf. 4[148]; si] 221.
 Cf. 4[184]; ZI "On Preachers of Death."
 Cf. 4[148].
 J; sin] 216. Cf. 4[152]. Cf. 5[27].
 191.
 {Cf. Ralph Waldo Emerson, Versuche (Essays), trans. G.
 Fabricius (Hanover: Carl Meyer, 1858), 361, cited in the
 Prelimi-
 nary Note by Mazzino Montinari to the Reference Matter to Z
 in
 CW 7; cf. also ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 2.}

193.
 194
 195.
 Cf. 1[72]; 5[1]65; ZI "On Preachers of Death."
 . Cf. ZI "On Preachers of Death."
 Cf. 12[9].
 196. Cf. ZI "On Preachers of Death" {N repeats the number
 234 for this fragment.
 197. {Cf. Gustav Teichmüller, Die wirkliche und die schein-
 bare
 Welt: Neue Grundlegung der Metaphysik ("The real and the ap-
 par-
 NOTES TO PAGES 192-195 651
 ent world: New foundation of metaphysics") (Breslau: Koebn-
 er,
 1882), 131-32.}
 Preface" 4}.
 199. Cf. 12[8]. {N is quoting from Teichmüller, Die wirk-
 liche
 und die scheinbare Welt, 132.}
 200. {N here misquotes from Teichmüller, Die wirkliche und
 die scheinbare Welt, 246. The original – "Was werden soll
 und
 werden wird, ist der Grund dessen, was wird" – would be
 trans-
 lated: "What should become and what will become is the basis
 for what will be."}
 Isaiah 40:4, Luke 3:5}.
 211. Cf. 4[176]; 5[22]; 12[15]; 13[7]; 16[7]; Cws, 3116];
 32[9]; ZIV
 "The Leech."
 652 NOTES TO PAGES 196-200
 225. moments of great contempt] die großen Verachtungen
 232. them] ihn {Refers to those being taught rather than the
 superhumans; cf. 4[208].}
 234. icons] Bilder
 241. news] Wort
 243. Cf. 4[229, 210, 228, 96, 224, 214, 175, 114]; ZI "Za-
 rathus-
 tra's Preface" 4; "On the Viper's Bite"; "On the Flies of
 the Mar-
 ketplace"; "On Child and Marriage."
 244. {Cf. 4[100, 210, 228]; 5[7].}
 245. {Cf. 3[1] 211; 4[96]; ZI "On the Viper's Bite."}
 246. {Cf. 4[175]; sl1] 253.}
 247. {Cf. 4[114]; si] 176; 16[9]; 22[3]_563.}

248. {Cf. 3[1] 1225 12[1] 111.}

249. neighbors] der Nächste {N uses the biblical term for "fel-
low human being," as in "Love thy neighbor as thyself."}

251. Cf. si] 197; 5[30]; ZI "On the Virtue of Gift-Giving";
"Zarathustra's Preface" 3.

252. beyond this earth] überirdisch {We do not have one Eng-
lish
term that renders the "super" of N's intended meaning, so we
paraphrase here.}

NOTES TO PAGES 200-208 653

259. reveals] verrättht

263. clown] Hanswurst {The clown-buffoon of German and
Austrian improvisational theatre, with roots in the Italian
comme-
dia del arte. By Luther's time, the name had become a pejor-
ative
term for anyone of unsophisticated and clownish demeanor}

265. Cf. sii] 197; slig]; ZI "Zarathustra's Preface" 3;
{4[6]; si]
103}.

266. terra incognita] "unknown land"

268. {Cf. 4[271].}

BGE 183; Z I "On the Viper's Bite."

270. {Cf. 5[17].}

271. {Cf. 4[68].}

272. {Cf. 4[71].}

273. {Cf. 4192}.}

[6 = M III 3b.]

1 Cf. 6[2, 3, 4]; the dating determined on the basis of the
draft of a letter from N to Lou von Salomé (M III 3, 18-19)
{KGB
Il:1, 295-96}; cf. Pfeiffer 263 et passim. {The organization
of the
fragments in this notebook have been altered to follow the
orga-
nization as found in N's handwritten notebook.}

2. Asceticism] Ascetism {N appears to use the terms Ascetism
and Ascetismus interchangeably.}

3. one] {KSA/KGW mistakenly underline eine; see <http://www.nietzschesource.org/DFGA/M-III-3,10>.}

654 NOTES TO PAGES 208-214

4. {Cf. 4[51] and the corresponding note. This fragment has
been reformatted in accordance with the notebook; see
[http://
www.nietzschesource.org/DFGA/M-III-3,11](http://www.nietzschesource.org/DFGA/M-III-3,11).}

5. to renouncing] aufzugeben {KSA/KGW mistakenly fails to underline aufzugeben; see <http://www.nietzschesource.org/DFGA/> M-III-3,8.}
 [7 = M III 4b]
 1. Draft of "Morality for Moralists"; cf. N to Overbeck in the summer {14 August} of 1883 {KGB Ill:1, 427}: "In the meantime the outline for a 'Morality for Moralists'? completed." 7[201]; 24[27]; CW 15, 25[2]; CW 16, 34[213].
 2. egoist(ic) principle] {Cf. Eduard von Hartmann, Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins: Prolegomena zu jeder künftigen Ethik ("Phenomenology of moral consciousness: Prolegomena to every future ethics"), pt. 1: "Das pseudomoralische Bewusstsein" ("Pseudomoralistic consciousness") (Berlin: C. Duncker's Verlag, 1879), 1-102. NL.}
 3. Critical retrospective on BT, N's notes on the first edition (1872). {Where N cites from BT, we have used the language that appears in the translation by Sean D. Kirkland and Andrew J. Mitchell in CW 1.}
 4. innocence of becoming] Plans with this title also exist dating back to this time; cf. 8[26]; 14[1].
 5. principium individuationis] "principle of individuation"
 6. art... being] {Cf. BT "Foreword to Richard Wagner."}
 7. {N incorrectly writes "p. 54"; the line quoted appears on p. 34, BT 7}
 8. p. 82... existence] BT 15.
 9. "which stares... inscrutable") {BT 15.}
 10. p. 92 Quintessence.] BT 17 (Beginning).
 u. p. 102... art.] BT 18.
 13. "another... 120.] BT 21.
 15. p. 136... sense] BT 23 (Conclusion).
 16. p. 142... hope] BT 24 (Conclusion).
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 17. Lecky I 199.] {William Edward Hartpole Lecky,} Geschichte des Ursprungs und Einflusses der Aufklärung in Europa (His-

tory of
 the Rise and Influence of the Spirit of Rationalism in
 Europe), 2 vols.
 (London: Longmans, Green, 1865)}, trans. H. Jolowicz, 2
 vols.
 (Leipzig/Heidelberg{: C. F. Winter,} 1873), 1:199. NL.
 18. {"Reference to chap. 4 of Johann Joachim Winckelmann,
 Gedanken über die Nachahmung der griechischen Werke in der
 Malerei
 und Bildhauerkunst ("Thoughts on the imitation of Greek
 works in
 painting and sculpture") (1755).
 19. the image of the sufferer] das Bild Leidenden {The gen-
 itive
 article is missing}
 Bewusstseins, 776.
 21. evil conscience] böses Gewissen {As opposed to "bad con-
 science" / schlechtes Gewissen.}
 22. Rée] On the critical dialogue with Paul Rée, cf. 7[24,
 48,
 137]; 15[47]; 1615]; 16[18]; 17[49]; CW 15, 25[259]; 26[202,
 218]; CW
 16, 35[34]; 38[18]; GM Preface 4-7; EH "Books" HAH.
 23. intérêt] "interest"
 24. plaisir) "pleasure"
 25. moral theory] Moralistik {A pun on Optik, giving the nu-
 ance
 of an academic subject, e.g., Germanistik.}
 26. noblesse] "nobility"
 27. superpowerful] Übermächtiger
 29. {Following Leopold Schmidt, Die Ethik der alten Griechen
 ("The ethics of the ancient Greeks"), 2 vols. (Berlin: Wil-
 helm
 Hertz [Bessersche Buchhandlung], 1882), vol. 1. NL.}
 30. women] Frauen
 31. Reverence for elders... modern] Cf. Schmidt, Die Ethik
 der
 alten Griechen, 2:304: "in the Greek world elders were
 revered
 about as much as women are revered in the modern world."
 Griechen, 2:314.}
 33. {Cf. Menander's play Farmer: "The best man, Gorgias, is
 the
 man who knows/How to take many unrequited blows;/This quick-
 ness to resent things, this excess/Of virulence, prove lit-
 tlemindedness."

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See John Maxwell Edmonds, *The Fragments of Attic Comedy*, vol. 2

(Leiden: E. J. Brill, 1961), 587.}

34. unfreedom of the will] Unfreiheit des Willens

35. What would the commonalities . . . (Tertullian)] {These paragraphs were 7[23] in KSA, but were moved by Montinari to the end of 7[22] in the revised later edition of KGW}

37. That which ... itself] {This paragraph was included at the end of 7[22] in KSA, but was made 7[23] by Montinari in the re-

vised later edition of KGW}

38. Cf. note to 7[17]. {Cf Paul Rée, *Der Ursprung der moralischen Empfindungen* (The Origin of Moral Sensations) (Chem-

nitz: Schmeitzner, 1877), §4, 52-58. NL.}

39. Written following the reading of Hartmann's *Phänomenologie*, cf. note to 7[10].

40. {Cf. WP 1026.}

41. {Cf. WP 1026.}

42. those who are not self-interested] des Uneigennütigen

43. {Cf. Spinoza, *Ethics*, Proposition 26: "Whatsoever we endeavor in obedience to reason is nothing further than to under-

stand; neither does the mind, in so far as it makes use of reason,

judge anything to be useful to it, save such things as are condu-

cive to understanding." Cf. also Hartmann, *Phänomenologie des*

sittlichen Bewusstseins, 12.}

Roux's *Kämpfe der Theile im Organismus* {: Ein Beitrag zur Vervoll-

ständigung der mechanischen Zweckmässigkeitslehre ("Struggle of

the parts within the organism: A contribution to the comple-

tion of the doctrine of mechanical expediency") (Leipzig: Engel-

mann, 1881), NL.}; cf. note to CW 13, 11[128].

45. "he is... collected"] {Cf. Paul Deussen, *Das System des Vedānta nach den Brahma-sūtra's des Bādarāyana und dem commentare des Cankara* (Leipzig: F. A. Brockhaus, 1883), 444.

NZ;
translated by Charles Johnston as *The System of the Vedanta Accord-*

ing to Badardya's Brahma-sūtras and Cankara's Commentary Thereon Set Forth as a Compendium of the Dogmatics of Brahman-

ism from the Standpoint of Cankara (Chicago: Open Court, 1912),

411; translation modified.}

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46. {Cf. Hartmann, Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins, 10.}

47. {Cf. Hartmann, Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins, 181-82.}

48. that's... thought] Looking back to the time period 1869-75.

49. prudential morality] {Cf. Hartmann, Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins, 15ff.}

50. "Hints... philosophy." Cf. CW 13, 11[195].

51. moral insanity] {In English in the original. Cf. Henry Mauds-

ley, Zurechnungsfähigkeit der Geisteskranken (Leipzig: Brockhaus,

1875), 164-67. NL. Authorized German translation of Responsibility

in Mental Disease (New York: D. Appleton, 1875), 170-73.}

52. "No one... herself!"] {N's translation of the line from Stendhal quoted in 7[46]. This is also how Stendhal's line appears

in the German translation, Über die Liebe, in Stendhal, Gesam-

melte Werke, ed. and trans. Friedrich von Oppeln-Bronikowski (Berlin: Im Propyläen, 1921), 4:54.}

53. Napoleon . . . century.] {According to KGW Nachbericht, this line belongs in 7[45]. KSA 10 had this as the entirety of 7[46].}

54. Stendhal... donner."} {According to KGW Nachbericht, this is a separate fragment. KSA to had this as the first paragraph

of 7[43]: "If a lady doesn't succeed in finding someone willing to

take her, she will still succeed in finding someone she can sell

herself to." Cf. Stendhal, De l'amour (Paris: Michel Lévy Frères,

1857), 38. NL.}

59. {WP 725.}

Death of Empedocles, st version, 1417. See The Death of Empedocles: A Mourning-Play, trans. David Farrell Krell (Albany: State University of New York Press, 2009), 87.}

61. {Cf. 7[47, 62, 125]; 8[26]; 24[16, 27].}

62. {Cf. 7[47, 58, 62, 125]; 8[26]; 24[16, 27].}

63. is experienced] wird... durchgemacht

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65. feeling!] Gefühl!

66. {This line from Ihering is cited in J. J. Baumann, Handbuch der Moral nebst Abriß der Rechtsphilosophie ("Handbook of morality along with an outline of the philosophy of jurisprudence") (Leipzig: S. Hirzel, 1879), 387-88. NL. Cf. Rudolf von Ihering, Der Zweck im Recht ("The purpose of law") (Leipzig: Breitkopf & Hartel, 1883), 2:191, 212, 226.}

67. Anact... etc] {Cf. Albert Hermann Post, Bausteine für eine allgemeine Rechtswissenschaft auf vergleichend-ethnologischer Basis ("Building blocks for a general jurisprudence on a comparative-ethnological basis"), 2 vols. (Oldenburg: Schultz, 1880/1), 1:224. NL.}

69. moralize] moralisieren {Moralisieren has a broader meaning in German, beyond "sermonizing" or "preaching," having to do with "thinking morally" or "exercising moral categories."}

70. consequences . . . feelings] Folgen . . . Empfindung {We usually render Empfindung as "sensation" when Gefühl is present in the same fragment, but here the context calls for "feelings."}

71. {Cf. note 67 above.}

72. surl amour v. p. 252.] N's copy no longer extant in N's Library. {Cf. Stendhal, De / amour, 252, where he refers to Helvétius.}

73. "le plaisir"] "pleasure"

74. Cf. Eugen Dühring, Kursus der Philosophie als streng wissenschaftlicher Weltanschauung und Lebensgestaltung ("Course of

philosophy as strictly scientific worldview and guide to life")
 (Leipzig{: Koschny,} 1875), 147. NL. {Nietzsche misquotes Dühring, whose text reads: "sein mechanischer Zustand stets ein Theilzustand der universellen Mechanik des Kosmos ist" (its [the body's] mechanical state is always a partial condition of the universal mechanics of the cosmos).}

75. {According to Roux.}

76. {Cf. Schmidt, Die Ethik der alten Griechen, 2:403ff.}

77. Cf. note to CW, 11[128]; {cf. Roux, Der Kampf der Theile im Organismus, 73-89).
 struggle of parts for space in the exchange of materials, or the

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struggle for nutrients in cases of shortages thereof with or without the effect of stimuli, newly developing characteristics can win out and spread in direct ways, namely in direct competition with the old ones, whereby the latter are either directly destroyed or consumed, assimilated (assimilation itself is certainly most universal and progressive process)."

80. the... weaker] Cf. *ibid.*, 91.

81. the advantage... rule] Cf. *ibid.*, 76-78.

82. When . . . nourishment.] CF. *ibid.*, 75: "If there is a lack of nutrients for an extended time, then it is true that struggle for space can take place, but only those connections will remain which cet. par. [all other things being equal] use the least material for replication, whereas other processes are simply starved out, thus disappearing by means of self-elimination."

84. ira] "wrath"

87. Cf. *ibid.*, 63: "Furthermore, the position seems to me to be justified that Darwin articulates in an outstanding example, without developing the underlying principle, when he mentions

that, with increasing age, people's handwriting sometimes comes to resemble that of their father. The basis for this lies in the thought that inherited acquired characteristics of ancestors, instead of reestablishing themselves after youth and adolescence, can be suppressed by means of shaping influences of the outside world on impressionable youth still capable of assimilation, and not until ripe old age, when this interaction with the outside world has become less extensive, do they become more and more prevalent. Correspondingly, I believe I have observed that family characteristics in men, especially psychological ones, sometimes develop and appear more and more in old age, after they have been suppressed by pedagogical influences outside the family."

89. inequality] Ungleichheit {This could also be "dissimilarity."}

91. Processes . . . fructification.] Cf. *ibid.*, 79; in places copied word for word.

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92. The... stimulus.] Cf. *ibid.*, 81: "in the process of which the more reactive substance took on relatively more stimuli."

96. forms] Arten

98. are not superfluously "prudent":] überflüssiger Weise "klug" ist:

99. itis our custom] bei uns {In German this can refer to national, regional, or ethnic customs and practices.}

100. Public-spiritedness] Gemeinsucht {This appears to be N's coinage, occurring only in this notebook.}

101. Great men] Große Menschen {translated here in deference to the "great man" theory of N's time; cf. Thomas Carlyle, *Heroes*,

Hero-Worship, and the Heroic in History (London: Fraser, 1841), 47:

"The History of the world is but the Biography of great men"}.
 102. un-noble] unnoble
 103. to those who have ears to hear it.] {Cf. Matthew 11:15, Mark 4:9.}
 104. {Cf. 7[47, 58, 62]; 8[26]; 24[16, 27].}
 105. advantage and ulterior advantage] Nutzen und Hinter-nutzen
 106. Mainländer] Philipp Mainländer, Die Philosophie der Er-lösung ("The philosophy of redemption"), and ed. (Berlin: Grieben,} 1876),
 107. "the gleam . . . themselves." {Cf. *ibid.*, 65.}
 108. "comparable... temperaments") {Cf. *ibid.*, 58.}
 109. {This list of qualities is copied from *ibid.*, 57-58.}
 110. {Cf. *ibid.*, 59, for these modifications.}
 ui. Cf. note to 7[17].
 112. debate] Kampf {Usually translated as "struggle".
 113. "The condition . . . limb." {Citation from Ernst Heinrich Weber, Untersuchungen über den Erregungsprozess im Muskel- und Nervensystem ("Investigations of the process of stimulation in the muscle and nervous system") (Leipzig, 1870). Cf. Michael Foster, Lehrbuch der Physiologie, trans. Nicolaus Kleinberg (Heidelberg: Winter, 1881), 502; originally published as A Textbook of Physiology (London: Macmillan, 1877), 413: "And in all the movements of our body we are conscious, even to an astonishingly accurate degree, as is well seen in the discussions concerning vision, of the amount of the contraction to which we are putting our muscles. In some way or other we are made aware of what particular muscles or groups of muscles are being thrown into action, and to what extent that action is being carried." (It should be noted that Kleinberg's German translation differs significantly from Foster's Eng-

lish text.)

Foster draws heavily upon Weber's work.}

114. Cold... Weber)] {Cf. Foster, Lehrbuch der Physiologie, 499; A Textbook of Physiology, 410: "And Weber has pointed out

that cold bodies feel heavier than hot bodies of the same weight."}

us. When 2... skin.] {Cf. Foster, Lehrbuch der Physiologie, 497; A Textbook of Physiology, 409: "When two sensations follow

each other in the same spot at a sufficiently short interval they are

fused into one; ... When sensations are generated at points of

the skin too close together they become fused into one."}

116. {Cf. Mainländer, Die Philosophie der Erlösung, 60-62.}

117. "which call... solitude"] {Cf. Ralph Waldo Emerson, Versuche (Essays), trans. G. Fabricius (Hanover: Carl Meyer, 1858),

393. NL. Originally published in English as The Collected Works

of Ralph Waldo Emerson, vol. 3: Essays, Second Series (Cambridge,

MA: Belknap Press of Harvard University Press, 1983), 100.}

118. "these delights . . . sober."} {Cf. Emerson, Versuche, 392; Essays,

Second Series, 100. The full sentence, which Nietzsche truncates,

reads in the original "These enchantments are medicinal, they sober and heal us."}

119. {Cf. WP 941.}

120. everlasting] das Unvergängliche {Probably a reference to

the conclusion of Goethe's Faust II.}

121. {WP 61}

122. {Cf. Gustav Teichmüller, Die wirkliche und die scheinbare

Welt: Neue Grundlegung der Metaphysik ("The real and the apparent world: New groundwork of metaphysics") (Breslau: Koebner, 1882), 204.}

123. {Cf. Emerson, Versuche, 410; Essays, Second Series, 112:

"To the intelligent, nature converts itself into a vast

- promise."}
124. {Cf. Schmidt, Die Ethik der alten Griechen, 1:232.}
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125. the work of the gods] Werk der Götter {The verb is omitted.}
127. {Cf. Schmidt, Die Ethik der alten Griechen, 1:168ff.}
128. {Cf. ibid., 170.}
129. {Cf. ibid., 267-68; 26Qç = surfeit; Üßgtg = hubris}
130. {Cf. ibid., 261.}
31. {Cf. ibid., 260.}
132. {Cf. Homer, Miad 18.107-110.}
133. {Cf. Schmidt, Die Ethik der alten Griechen, 266.}
134. {Cf. ibid., 281.}
135. {Cf. ibid.}
136. {WP 758.}
137. otium] "leisure"
138. feeling] Empfindung {This could also be "perception."}
139. {Cf. Schmidt, Die Ethik der alten Griechen, 274.}
141. {Cf. Karl Semper, Die natürlichen Existenzbedingungen der Thiere ("The natural conditions of existence of animals"), 2 vols. (Leipzig: Brockhaus, 1880), 1:18-19, 236-37, 241-42, 218-19; 2:222-23, 257. NL}
142. the creator] die Schöpferin {N uses the term Schöpferin ("female creator"), which refers back to the feminine noun Sympathie ("sympathy").}
143. {Cf. Alfred Espinas, Die tierischen Gesellschaften: Eine vergleichend-psychologische Untersuchung ("Animal societies: A comparative-psychological examination"), trans. W. Schlosser (Braunschweig: Vieweg, 1879), 367-68. NL.}
144. {Cf. Hartmann, Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins, 591.}
145. {Cf. Roux, Der Kampf der Theile im Organismus, 37.}
146. {Cf. Leon Dumont, Vergnügen und Schmerz: Zur Lehre von den Gefühlen ("Pleasure and pain: On the doctrine of the feelings") (Leipzig: Brockhaus, 1876), 30-31. NL.}
147. {Cf. Schmidt, Die Ethik der alten Griechen, 269.}
148. {Cf. Hartmann, Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins, chap. 1.}
149. competition] Kampf
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150. {Cf. Schmidt, Die Ethik der alten Griechen, 2:273.}

151. {Cf. *ibid.*, 274.}
 152. {Cf. *ibid.*, 342.}
 153. {Cf. *ibid.*, 353.}
 154. {Cf. *ibid.*, 358.}
 155. {CA *ibid.*, 357.}
 156. {Cf. *ibid.*}
 157. {Cf. *ibid.*, 361.}
 158. {Cf. *ibid.*, 362.}
 159. {Cf. Roux, Der Kampf der Theile im Organismus, 96-97.}
 160. {Cf. *ibid.*, 98.}
 161. {Cf. *ibid.*, 102.}
 162. {Cf. *ibid.*, 110.}
 163. {Cf. *ibid.*; altered quote.}
 164. open-mindedness] Freisinnigkeit
 165. {Cf. *ibid.*, 149.}
 166. {Cf. *ibid.*, 151.}
 167. Georg Heinrich Schneider, Der thierische Wille: Systematische Darstellung und Erklärung der thierischen Triebe und deren Entstehung, Entwicklung und Verbreitung im Thierreiche als Grundlage zu einer vergleichenden Willenslehre ("The animal will: Systematic description and analysis of the animal drives and their emergence, development, and distribution in the animal world as the basis of a comparative study of the will") (Leipzig{: Abel} 1880), 29. NZ. In the passage cited by N, Schneider gives a definition of the rudimentary organs as no longer functional; they "once had a purpose": this is true – according to N in this fragment and in other passages – of "evil people."
 168. a person's ability to know absolutely (be known absolutely)] an der absoluten Erkenntniß (Erkantheit)
 170. {Cf. Hartmann, Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins, Sf.}
 171. {Cf. *ibid.*, 6off.}
 174. @Qdvnoaic] "practical wisdom"
- 664 NOTES TO PAGES 274-280
176. {Cf. *ibid.*, sff.}

180. confidently expect a lot of ourselves] von uns viel versprechen
können {N is playing with different meanings of the verb versprechen}

183. {Cf. *ibid.*, 39.}

184. {Cf. Arthur Schopenhauer, *Sämtliche Werke*, vol. 3: *Der Welt als Wille und Vorstellung*, vol. 2, ed. Julius Frauenstadt (Leipzig: F. A. Brockhaus, 1877), 731. NL. Translated in English by Judith Norman, Alistair Welchman, and Christopher Janaway as *The World as Will and Representation* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2017), 652.}

185. {Schopenhauer, *Parerga and Paralipomena* 2, §172, cited in Hartmann, *Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins*, 43.}

187. Cf. Teichmüller, *Die wirkliche und die scheinbare Welt*, {82-83}.

188. Concerning a critique of Hartmann's *Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins*.

189. {Cf. Hartmann, *Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins*, 26.}

190. *facta*] "facts"

191. {WP 698}

192. *sull'indole del piacere e del dolore*)] "On the Nature of Pleasure and Pain"

193. *il solo principio . . . essere positivo.*] {"the only moving principle of man is pain. Pain precedes every pleasure[.] Pleasure is not a positive state." Cf. Dumont, *Vergnügen und Schmerz*, 35-36. Kant notes this endorsement of the Milanese philosopher Count Pietro Verri (1728-97), whose words he paraphrases, in §58 of *Anthropology from a Pragmatic Point of View*. Kant was familiar with Verri's work *Idee sull'indole del piacere* (1774) in its German translation by Christoph Meiners, *Gedanken über die Natur des Vergnügens* ("Thoughts on the nature of pleasure") (Leipzig: Weygand,

1777).}

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194. chronic] wiederkehrender {Cf. Dumont, Vergnügen und Schmerz, 36.}

195. {Cf. *ibid.*, 37.}

196. {Cf. *ibid.*, 32.}

197. {Cf. Schneider, *Der thierische Wille*, 58.}

198. On the concept "Jesuitism," cf. Hartmann, *Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins*, 567-69, {645-48}.

200. {Cf. 16[41].}

202. robs] beraubt {N added a period after beraubt and then continues with its genitive objects.}

203. noblest] höchsten {In most cases, we translate the adjective

höchst as "supreme." Here we prefer "noblest" to reflect English

usage with "end."}

206. {Cf. *ibid.*}

207. Cf. Post, *Bausteine für eine allgemeine Rechtswissenschaft*,

1:201.

208. {Cf. *ibid.*, 214.}

210. center of gravity] Schwergewicht

213. voluntary] willkürlich

Waldo Emerson, vol. 2: *Essays, First Series* (Cambridge, MA: Har-

vard University Press, 1979), 78: "There is less intention in history

than we ascribe to it."

219. Cf. Hartmann, *Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins*,

599.

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[8 = Mp XVII 1a.]

L {Cf. Gustav Klemm, *Allgemeine Cultur-Geschichte der Mensch-*

heit, Band 4: *Die Urzustände der Berg- und Wüstenvölker der activen*

Menschheit und deren Verbreitung über die Erde ("Universal cultural

history of humanity, vol. 4: *The primordial states of the nomadic*

mountain and desert peoples and their expansion over the earth")

(Leipzig: B. G. Teubner, 1845), 370.}

2. {Cf. Oscar Peschel, *Völkerkunde* ("Ethnology") (Leipzig:

Duncker & Humblot, 1874): 176-77.}

3. {Cf. Gustav Klemm, Allgemeine Cultur-Geschichte der Menschheit, Band 6: China und Japan (Leipzig; B. G. Teubner, 1847), 130-31.}

4. {Cf. Peschel, Völkerkunde, 454.}

5. {Cf. John Lubbock, Die Entstehung der Zivilisation und der Urzustand des Menschengeschlechtes, erläutert durch das innere und äußere Leben der Wilden, trans. A. Passow (Jena: H. Costenoble, 1875), 15-16. NL. Originally published as The Origin of Civilization and the Primitive Condition of Man: Mental and Social Condition of Savages, 3rd ed. (London: Longmans, Green, 1875.)}

6. The Siamese... rice.] {Cf. David Kaltbrunner, Der Beobachter: Allgemeine Anleitung zu Beobachtungen über Land und Leute für Touristen, Exkursionisten, und Forschungsreisende ("The observer: General guide for tourists, hikers, and researchers on making observations about a land and its people") (Zurich: J. Wurster, 1881), 676-78. NL.}

7. -justas... mist] {Cf. James Bell Pettigrew, Die Ortsbewegung der Thiere: Nebst Bemerkungen über Luftschiffahrt (Leipzig: Brockhaus, 1875), 8; originally published as Animal Locomotion: or Walking, Swimming and Flying, with a Dissertation on Aeronautics (London: Henry S. King, 1873).}

8. -justas... its wings)] {Cf. ibid., 177.}

9. {Cf. 16[63, 83], 18[3], 20[3, 16], 21[1, 2], 23[9].} Die Ortsbewegung der Thiere, 7{f.}.
u. Cf. GM III 17.

12. {Cf. William Shakespeare, Was ihr wollt, trans. August Wilhelm von Schlegel, in Shakespeares dramatische Werke in 9 Bänden, vol. 4, trans. August Wilhelm von Schlegel und Ludwig Tieck (Berlin:

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Georg Reimer, 1854), act 1, scene 3, 133. NL. N cites the standard German translation and refers to "Sir Andrew Aguecheek" by his character name in the Schlegel-Tieck translation: "Junker Christoph."

14. {Many of N's notes here and in the remainder of this note-

book can be traced to his reading of Albert Hermann Post, Bausteine für eine allgemeine Rechtswissenschaft auf vergleichend-ethnologischer Basis ("Building blocks for a general jurisprudence

on a comparative-ethnological basis"), vol. 1 (Oldenburg: Schulz,

1880); vol. 2 (Oldenburg: Schulz, 1881). NZ.}

15. {Cf. *ibid.*, 1:191.}

16. {Cf. *ibid.*, 1:58, 73-74, 77, 81, 82, 85, 92-98, 103, 104, 108-

13, 122-243 2:37-38, 46-47, 55.}

17. *jus primae noctis*] "the right of the first night" {Often referred to by medievalists writing in English as the "droit du seigneur."

It refers to the putative right of the lord to sleep with any peasant bride on her wedding night.}

18. young females] Weibchen {This is the standard German term for the female of the species in animals.}

19. in our culture] bei uns

20. *separatio quoad thorum et mensam*] "separation from bed and table" {An ecclesiastical decree that allowed husband and wife to live separate lives without annulling the marital bond.}

21. *noAig*] "polis," i.e., "city-state"

22. {Cf. Post, Bausteine für eine allgemeine Rechtswissenschaft, 2:55.}

23. even old Don Quixote!] noch der Don Quixote! {We provide an equivalent for N's use of the definite article with a proper name, associated in German with provincial or dialect usage.}

24. {Cf. Post, Bausteine für eine allgemeine Rechtswis-

senschaft,
 2:76-77, 88, 119-21, 217.}

25. blood debts] Blutgeld {The traditional English term for Blutgeld is the Old English term "wergild," or literally, "man-money," the amount of compensation paid by a person committing an offense to the injured party. We translate it as "blood debt" to make the term accessible to modern readers and to distinguish it from "blood money," which has a different sense.}

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Die thierischen Gesellschaften: Eine vergleichend-psychologische Untersuchung ("Animal societies: A comparative-psychological investigation"), trans. W. Schloesser (Braunschweig: Vieweg, 1879),
 525-27. NL. Originally published in French as Des sociétés animales: Etude de psychologie comparée, and ed. (Paris: Bail-
 liere, 1878).}

34. {WP 771}

35. sacrificio dell'intelletto] "sacrifice of the intellect" {N underlines sacrificio}.

36. what is there, still so good] das Vorhandene noch so gute {N places two phrases here side by side, with the probable meaning of "no matter how good."}

38. {N's page references here and below are to Leopold Schmidt, Die Ethik der alten Griechen ("The ethics of the ancient Greeks"), vol. 2 (Berlin: Verlag von Wilhelm Hertz [Bessersche Buchhandlung], 1882). NL.}

39. refuted] gefälscht.

40. {On Baltasar Gracián, cf. N's letter to Heinrich Köselitz of 20 September 1884, KGB III:1, 535.}

42. they] man {A better rendering than "we" here, because N is

referring to all Greeks.}

43. yv@di oavtónj "know thyself"

44. subtext] Hintergedanken {See Grimm 10, 1503.}

45. modove . . . Xivaioa.] "Plato in front, Plato in back, Chi-
maera in the middle." Paraphrase of Jad 6.181, where the
chimaera
is described as "lion-fronted and snake behind, a goat in
the mid-
dle." Cf. BG E 190.

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46.

47.

48. 49.

50.

SI.

52. 53. 54. 55. 56.

{WP 787}

{Cf. 7[7] and corresponding note.}

{WP 372.}

good people] Heading added in the summer of 1888.

{WP 418.}

{WP 574; cf. BGE Preface, 16, 17, 54.}

Cf. 7[268].

{Cf. 7[7] and corresponding note.} {Cf. 16[33].}

{Cf. 7[47, 58, 62, 125]; 24[16, 27].}

{WP 10.}

9 =NVL.)

I.

Collection of sayings and turns of phrase related to Z II;
for
the most part adopted in 13[1].

8. 9.

{Cf. 12[43]; 13f]_373; 13[9].}

{Cf. 13[1]_373.}

{Cf. 13[1]_373.} {Cf. 13[1]_374.} {Cf. 13[1]_374.}

. I you and he.] Ich Du und Er {N capitalizes the pronouns
here.}

{Cf. 13[1] 371); 13[11]; 16[4]; 22[1]_548.}

{Cf. 13[1]_372.}

Cf. Z II "The Prophet"; {cf. 13[1]_373.}

snored] röchelte {Röcheln, to snore, to wheeze, to snuffle,
has connotations of a death rattle.}

12. 13. 14. 15. 16. 17.

13[1]_380; 16

18.

19.

Arrangement of ZI.

As in 9l1]; {cf. 13[1]_380}.

to convert to my cause] euch zu mir bekehren

"Party liner] "Mensch der Partei"

surge] Brandung {As in the sense of surf or the ocean; cf. 7); 22[1]_550.}

1]{_396; 13[6]}; Z II "On Virtuous People."

1){_376}; Z II "The Child with the Mirror."

1){_376; 13[12]}.

Cf. 13 Cf. 13 Cf. 13

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21. Cf. Z II "On Virtuous People."

25. {Cf. 13[1]_378.}

27. {Cf. 13[1]_389, 13[12]; 16[7].}

28. bark] Kahn {A larger, open river- or sea-going vessel, usu-

ally with one mast, used for cargo on rivers or in coastal trade; in

Nalso a general term for sea-going vessel.}

29. {Cf. 13[1]_389; 16[7]; 22[1]_550.}

30. {Cf. 13[1]_389; 16[7]; 22[1]_550.}

32. {Cf. 13[1]_390; 16[7]; 22[1]_549.}

33. {Cf. 9[18]; 13[1]_389.}

36. {Cf. 13[1]_393; 13[8]; 16[7]; 22[1]_549.}

38. Lavie... qui pense.] "Life is a tragedy for those who feel,

and a comedy for those who think." {The line "The world is a comedy to those that think; a tragedy to those that feel" appears

often in Walpole's letters; the line "La vie est une tragédie pour

ceux qui sentent, et une comédie pour ceux qui pensent" is also

attributed to Jean de la Bruyère.}

40. removing mountains] Berge versetzen {An allusion to Paul's

words on love from 1 Corinthians 13:2.}

43. grace] Anmuth

48. {Cf. BGE 260.}

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so. Cf. 13[2].

54. they shoot off their mouths; we are supposed to think that this

is out of the abundance of their hearts.] sie nehmen den Mund voll;

man soll meinen, das Herz gehe ihnen über. {N is playing off the biblical passage in Matthew 12:34, "for out of the abundance of the heart the mouth speaketh," which Luther translates as "Wes das Herz voll ist, des geht der Mund über." In substituting the idiom den Mund vollnehmen, meaning "to shoot off one's mouth," N puts the hypocrisy in the worst possible light. Luther was particularly proud of this translation, and cites it in his 1530 Open Letter on Translating}

ss. {Cf. 12[42]; 13[20].}

56. {Cf. 13[1]_372; 16[4]; 22[1]_549.}

60. {Cf. 3l1] 49; 12[1] 119; 12[42, 43]; 13[6].}

61. Individuum est aliquid novum] "The individual is something new"

62. {The addition of the definite article is needed to render the clarity of N's German.}

63. {Cf. 12[42].}

67. Nacht ist es – nun reden
 lauter alle springenden Brunnen
 – und auch du, meine Seele
 bist ein springender Brunnen.
 Nacht ist es – nun erst erwachen
 alle Lieder der Liebenden.
 Und auch du, meine Seele, bist
 das Lied eines Liebenden.

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68. knowledge] Wissen

70. {Cf. Daniel Darc, Petit bréviaire du Parisien (Paris: Paul Ollendorff, 1883). N misspells Ollendorff's name.}

[10 = N VI.]

Cf. 13[3]{_402}. . Cf. 13[3] {404}.

Key terms in Z II (from earlier fragments).

. {Cf. 16[90].}

my I] mein Ich {The I is the subject of the sentence doing the dreaming. Cf. 10[10].}

7. hound of hell] Höllenhund {See the Translators' Afterword,

740-41, on the translation of Höllenhund.}

8. {Cf. 13[3]_400.}

u. Cf. 13[3]{_405; 10[41]; 13[17, 25]}.

12. {Cf. 10[35]; 17156]; 22[1]_552.}

15. the Corsican] {Napoleon}

18. {An allusion to Kant; cf. 10[40]; 13[24, 27]; 16[84]; 21[3].}

20. aging virgins] alter Mädchen {The term for "old maid" was alte Jungfer in N's time, which survives in modern German. Cf. Flügel ss1.}

DD "Amidst Birds of Prey."}

24. {Cf. 9[15]; 13[1]_372.}

25. Cf. 13[78]; {5[1] 213, 214; 12[1] 171; 12[13, 14]; 13[1]_375; allu- sion to the end of Goethe's Faust II, lines 12104-5}. Rwhre sn

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26. Cf. 13[1]{_377}.

29. Cf. 13[18]; 12[43].

35. your neck is too stiff] zu gerade im Rücken sein

38. Twilight of the gods] Götterdämmer {Not Götterdämmerung, which would be the title of the fourth and final opera in Wagner's Der Ring des Nibelungen.}

41. {Cf. 13[3]_407.}

42. Cf. Z II "The Tomb Song"; "The Stillest Hour"; {cf. 10[8]; 17[56]; 22[1]_552}.

43. word] Wort {We keep this in the singular in order to reflect "word" in the sense of John 1:1.}

48. Those who speak freely] Freisprecher {N could also be referring to acts of exoneration, but the context of the list indicates otherwise.}

II); fragments 10[46, 47] are also included.

52. {Cf. 16[4].}

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[11 =N VI)]

L Arrangement of Z II.

2. What is... vanity.] Cf. 12[44]; Z II "On Human Prudence."

3. Cf. Z II "The Child with the Mirror."

4. {Cf. 3l1} 245; 4[165]; 18[43, 49, 56]; 21[6]; 24[16].}

5. {Cf. 9[48]; 18[55].}

. Refers to a third part of Z (immediately following or during the writing of Z II).

7. {Cf. 22[1]_558.}

8. Cf. BGE 83.

9. Arrangement of Z II. . Cf. 13[r]. . Cf. 13[13]. . Arrangement of Z II. . Arrangement of Z II.

NY

a)

D HM ©

= w

{12 = Z,}

1. Published for the first time as an annual issue (1975/76) for "Authors and Friends of the House of De Gruyter." Collection of sayings from HAH, MM, WS, D, and JS, as well as from earlier notebooks from the period 1882/83; with emendations and changes; used for Z II, II, IV, BGE. {In an effort to follow the editorial decision to maintain translation consistency across the CW volumes, we have used the language of the already published translations by Gary Handwerk of HAH, MM, and WS, by Brittain Smith of D, and by Adrian Del Caro of BGE, making changes only where we deemed it necessary in order to maintain consistency with our global translation decisions.}

2. {Cf. HAH 482.}

3. {Cf. HAH 483.}

4. {Cf. HAH 494.}

5. {Cf. HAH 498.}

6. {Cf. HAH 504.}

7. {Cf. HAH 506.}

8. {Cf. HAH 508.}

9. {Cf. HAH sis.}

10. {Cf. HAH 514.}

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II.

12. 13. 14. 15. 16. 17. 18.

19.

20. . {Cf. HAH 320.} . {Cf. HAH 308} . {Cf. HAH 301} . {Cf. HAH 295.}

{Cf. HAH 529.} {Cf. HAH 544.} {Cf. HAH 564.} {Cf. HAH 310.}

{Cf. HAH 582.} {Cf. HAH 580.} {Cf. HAH 575.} {Cf. HAH 402.}

{Cf. HAH 391.} {Cf. HAH 388.}

{Cf. MM 6}

. {Cf. MM 406.} . {Cf. MM 402.} . {Cf. MM 390.} . {Cf. MM 378} . {Cf. MM 381.}

. {Cf. MM 368.} . {Cf. MM 362.} . {Ch MM 357.}

. spirit] Geist {This could also be understood as "mind."}
 . {Cf MM 353.} . {Cf. MM 348.} . {Cf. MM 341.}
 . {Cf. MM 313; John 12:14.}
 . {Cf. MM 309.} . {Cf MM 274.} . {Cf. MM 267} . {Cf. MM
 255.}
 . {Cf. MM 240} . {Cf. MM 202.}
 {Cf. MM 168.}
 . {See note 34 above.} . {Cf. MM 160.}
 675
 NOTES TO PAGES 346-348
 . {Cf. MM 136.} . {Cf MM 140.} . {Cf. MM 128.} . {Cf. MM
 120.4} . {Cf. MM 34.}
 . {Cf MM 36}
 . {Cf. MM 65.}
 . {Cf. 3[1] 341; 5[35]; 13[12].}
 . {Cf MM 773} . {Cf. MM 82.} . {Cf. WS 340.} . {Cf. WS 335.}
 . {CE WS 325.}
 . {Cf. WS 290.}
 62. {Cf WS 240.}
 64
 . {Cf WS 254.}
 . {Cf. WS 18. N here alludes to a saying of Diogenes the
 Cynic;
 cf. Diogenes Laertius, Lives of Eminent Philosophers 6.2, 6,
 41.}
 65.
 74 dum
 75: 76.
 {Cf. WS 55.} . {Cf. WS 120.}
 . {Cf. HAH 83.}
 . {Cf. HAH 76} . {Cf. HAH 66}
 . {Cf HAH 186.}
 . {Cf. HAH 187}
 . {Cf. HAH 560; cf. Matthew 25:14-30.}
 . {Cf. HAH 568}
 . "Should . . . into it." "Soll das Band nicht reifen –
 mußt
 al drauf beißen."
 {Cf. 1[97]; 3i] 51; BGE 140.}
 77. {Cf. D 557}
 78. 79. 80.
 81.
 {Cf. D 380.} . {Cf D 391.} . {Cf. D 299.} . {Cf D 249.} .
 {Cf. D 208.} . {Cf. D 185.} . {Cf. 301] 444.} . {Cf. 3[1]
 404.} . {Cf. 3l1 . {Ch 3i
 . {Cf. 301] 349; 13l16]; 1

. {Cf 3l1} 356.} . Women] Frauen . {Cf. 1[50]; 3[1] 351.} .
 {Cf. 3l1} 336.} . {Cf. 3[1] 3425 5[35].} . {Cf. 3[1] 338.}
 Tu
 . {Cf 3[1] 264; BGE 73}
 . {Cf 3[1] 270; BGE 73a.
 . {Cf. 3l1} 273; 13[8]; 1
 . {Cf 3[1] 249; BGE 101.
 . {Cf. BI] 243}; 13l16);
 BGE 99.}
 106. {Cf. 3[1] 251.}
 107. {Cf. 13[16], JS 214.}
 }]; } 16
 . {Cf. 3[1] 287; 4142, 200};
 677
 422; 22[3]_569; BGE 166.}
 394; 12[1] 89; 13[8].} 6[7];
 BGE 1169.}
 13[19].}
 6[7]; CW 15, 31[36]; 32[9].}
 [7]; 23[5]; CW 1s, 31[35, 36]; 3210];
 108. {Cf. 3[1] 202; BGE 162; the wordplay is between Näch-
 ster,
 Jesus's designation for a fellow human being, and, in the
 latter
 two, Nachbar, the term for someone living in close proxim-
 ity.}
 {Cf. 3[1] 206.}
 {Cf. 3[1] 170; 13[8].} {Cf. 3[1] 138}
 {Cf. 30] 141; BGE 170.} {Cf. 301] 139; 31] 393.} {Cf. 3[1]
 139.}
 {Cf. 301] 122; s[17].} {Cf. 3l1} 77}
 III.
 112. 113. 114.
 678
 NOTES TO PAGES 351-354
 117. grab us by the scruff of the neck] am Schopfe fassen
 {Cf. 3[1]
 86; BGE 179}
 118. 119.
 122.
 123. 12
 {Cf. 2[41]; 3[1] 66; CW 15, 3152]; 32[9].}
 {Cf. 1[49], 3[1] 474
 {Cf BGE 141}
 {Cf. 30] 44.}
 {Cf. 3[1] 38; 22[3]_563.}

{Cf. 3[1] 49; 9[48]; 12[42, 43]; 1316].}

4. superior qualities . . . base qualities] das Hohe . . .
 dessen
 Niedriges {Cf. 1[92].}

125.
 126.
 127.
 128. 129. 130.
 131. 132. 133.
 134.
 {Cf. GM II x} {Cf. 4[53].} {Cf. 4[56].}
 dulce] "sweet" {Cf. 4[59] and note 70 in Nb 4 on Horace's
 Ars poetica.
 "sweetening things."}

136. 137.
 {Cf. 13[6]; 16[7].}
 {Cf. 4[64]; N is playing with the distinction between
 gerecht
 (just) and gerächt (avenged).}

138. 139.
 140. 141. 142. 143. 144. 145. 146. 147. 148.
 {Cf. 3[1] 389.}
 {Cf. 3[1] 217.}
 {Cf. sii]; 13[8]; BGE 81.}
 {Cf. 4[58].}
 {Cf. 3[9].}
 {Cf. 5[1] 20.}
 {Cf. 3[1] 3473 5133, 35]; BGE 183.}
 {Cf. 25[301].}
 {Cf. 3[1] 414.}
 {Cf. 3[1] 300; 13[14].}
 {Cf. 1[59]; 3i] 13; 4[226]; 13[14]; 16[7].}

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149. {Cf. 3[1] 328; 13[14]; 16[7].}
 150. {Cf. 3[1] 415}
 151. {Cf. 3[1] 234.}
 152. {Cf. 4[112]; si] 5.}
 153. {Cf. 4[131].}
 154. {
 156. {Cf. si] 193.}
 157. {Cf. 13[10]; D 48.}
 158. {Cf. 3[1] 260.}
 159. error veritate simplicior] "error is simpler than
 truth" {Cf.
 D 168.}

160. Ubi pater sum, ibi patria.] "Wherever I am father,

there is
the fatherland." {Reworking of the Latin expression ubi
panis, ibi
patria (where there is bread, there is [my] country).}
161. {Cf. D 235.}
162. Here where we live] Bei uns {This idiom locates the ac-
tion
or experience within a country, a region, or a community.}
163. {Cf. D 236.}
164. {Cf. D 535.}
165. {Cf. D 537.}
166. {Cf. {5[1] 213, 214; 10[17, 24]; 12[13, 14]; 13[1]_375;
13[18]; cf.
lines 12104-11 of Goethe's Faust II.}
167. {Cf. MM 325.}
168. {Cf. WS 131.}
169. {Cf. WS 132.}
170. {Cf. 3[1] 392.}
171. {Cf. 3[1] 402.}
172. {Cf. 3[1] 411}
173. {Cf. si] 554
174. {Cf. 1[5]; si] 60.}
175. {Cf. 2[r]; si] 109.}
176. {Cf. 3l1] 167.}
177. {Cf. 4[71]; sla) 14.}
178. {Cf. 3[1] 300.}
179. {Cf. 3[1] 94; BGE 150.}
180. {Cf. 1[85].}
680 NOTES TO PAGES 358-366
181. {Cf. 1[87, 108]; 5[1] 62; BGE 114.}
182. {Cf. 4[40]; s[1] 83.}
183. {Cf. 51] 112; BGE 118.}
184. {Cf. 4[77]; sh] 123.}
185. {Cf. 4[87].}
186. advocate] Anwalt
187. {Cf. 41199]; sl1] 264.}
188. {Cf. 3[1] 51, 60; 1[34, 79, 80]; 4144); sl1] 46.}
CW is, 31[6, 9].
t
[e]
193. {Cf. 4[160]; sl] 247; 13[17]; Isaiah 40:4.}
196. Cf. s[1] 234; Z II "On Those Who Are Sublime."
200. Cf. sl1] 213, 214; 13[1]{_375; 10l]; 12[1] 171}.
205. peach] Apfel {We switched the fruit (from "apple") in
order
preserve the wordplay with "fuzz."}

208. effect at a distance] {This is N's translation of actio in dis-

tans; cf. JS 60.}

209. the arc of the motion] Bewegungskurve

211. secondary manifestation] Nebenäußerung

(1786-1826), first performed 25 October 1823 in Vienna}

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214. {Cf. 3[1] 49; 9[48]; 12[1] 119; 12[43]; 13[6].}

215. {Cf. 9[48].}

216. Collection of fragments, used mostly for Z II "On Taran-

tulas"; cf. 13[1] as well.

217. {Cf. 3[1] 39; 9[48]; 12[1] 119; 12[42]; 13[6].}

218. {Cf. ol}; 13[1]_3685 13[9].} 219. {Cf. 13[1]_375.} 220.

{Cf. 13[1]_379.} 221. {Cf. 13[1]_379.} 222. {Cf. 13[1]_379.}

223. {Cf. 13[1]_383.} 224. {Cf. 13[1]_382.} 225. {Cf. 9[17];

13[1]_390.}

226. {Cf. 13[1]_397; 16[7]; 17[48]; 23[5]; 22[1]_553.}

227. {Cf. 10[21].}

13=Z.

1. Collection of sayings and turns of phrase for the most part

from Notebook 9 (N VI 2), and in part from Notebook 10 (N VI 3); enhanced by emendations; used for Z II and early drafts 13[6-9, I, 12, 14-19].

. {Cf. 9[14, 36, 56]; 13[20].}

. {Cf. oft.}

. {Cf. o[14].}

. {Cf. ofa}; 13[11]; 16[4]; 22[1] _375}

{Cf 9 l}

{Cf. i}

. {Cf. 9[45].}

. {Cf 12l14.}

u. {Cf olis, 45}; 10[17]; 16[4].}

12. {Cf. 9[49]}

13. {Cf. 9[3].}

14. {Cf. 9[13]; 13[1]_375; 12l11.}

15. [CA 16[4]; 22[1].}

16. {Cf. 9[46].}

Peyarayp

>] 0

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17. {Cf. ol1}; 12[43]; 13[9].} 18. {Cf. ol1.} 19. {Cf.

ol1.} 20. {Cf. 9l1.}

21. "Black on White"] {Probably a reference to a game similar

to mahjong.}

22. queen] Herrin {Herrin = "mistress," but this meaning in English is now obsolete, so we have opted for a different term for a female figure of authority.}

23. {Cf. 10[38].}

24. {Cf. 9[1].}

25. {Cf. 9[1].}

26. {Cf. 13[8].}

27. mere woman] Weibchen

28. {Cf. Genesis 2: 21-27}

29. {Cf. 9[30]; 13[11].}

30. {Cf. 9[30].}

31. in the tree "Future"] auf dem Baume Zukunft {The quotation marks are not in the German but are inserted here to indicate N's suggestion that this is the name of the tree.}

32. {Cf. 9[30]; 12[43].}

33. {Cf. 9[30].}

34. {Cf. 10[23, 24]; 12[1] 171.}

35. floating around right now] jetzt in der Luft liegen

36. {Cf. gl₁₁; 13[12].}

37. {Cf. 9l₁₀.}

42. {Cf. 16[4]; 22[1]_376.}

43. {Cf. 16[4]; 22[1]_377.}

44. {Cf. 10[18].}

45. Every intellect... my intellect.] Aller Geist . . . mein Geist

{This could also be "spirit" or "mind."}

46. {Cf. 9[ro].}

47. {Cf. 9l₁₆.}

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48. {Cf. 13[7].}

49. {Cf. 16[4]; 22[1]_549.}

so. {Cf. 9[23]; 13[1]_386.}

st. {Cf. 16[4]; 22[1]_549.}

52. {Cf. 13[11].}

53. {Cf. 12[9, 43].}

54. {Cf. 16[7]; 22[1]_550.}

ss. {Cf. 13[12]; 16[7]; 22[1]_550.} 56. {Cf. 9[6].}

57. {Cf. 9[6].}

63. {Cf. 9[53].}

64. {Cf. 13[7].}

65. Via Appia] {The Appian Way was one of the first and most important Roman roads, stretching 350 miles from the Roman Forum to modern-day Brindisi. Cf. 9[4]; 13[20].}

66. {Cf. 13[11]; 16[7]; 17[158]; 22[1]_551.}

67. {Cf. 13[6].}

68. {Cf. 12[43].}

69. {Cf. 12[43].}

70. boat] Nachen {An open vessel, about the size of a gondola,
propelled by oars or a longer oar, used for light cargo on rivers or
for transporting passengers to ships at anchor; in a letter
written
1 June 1859 (KGB I:1, 66) from his first year at Schulpforta
to his
childhood friend Wilhelm Pinder, N includes a poem in which
he uses this term for the boat in which Charon transports
the
dead to the Underworld.}

71. {Cf. 13[10, 14]; 16[7]; 22[1]_550.}

72. {Cf. 13[23].}

73. {Cf. 16[7]; 22[1].}

74. intellect . . . intellect.] Geist. . . Geist {This could
also be
rendered as "spirit."}

75. {Cf. 13[8].}

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NOTES TO PAGES 385-392

76. son of man] Menschensohn {Reflects the standard biblical
term.}

77- 78. 79.
. {Cf. 16[7]; 22[1]_549.} . {Cf. 4[210]; 5[9].}
. make better forecasts of human weather] daß sie die Wet-
ter-
zeichen des Menschen besser reden machen

90 91. Acts 92 Tanz
. {Cf. 9[18].}
{Cf. 9[18]; 16[7]; 22[1]_550; a reference to Pentecost. See
2:3.}
. this gold dances leaps and crouches] es hebt und senkt
sich der
dieses Gold {Our paraphrase reflects the more extensive
descrip-
tion in 9[18]; see also 16[7]; 22[1]_550.}

93. 94.
95.
96. 97.
98 99
{Cf. 9[18], 13[12]; 16[7].}

. {Cf. 9[19]; 13[18]; 16[7].}
100. {Cf. 9[19]; 16[7]; 22[1]_549.}
101. Did not cry out Nol] Riefen nicht Nein! {There is no
subject
referent for the verb "Riefen."}
102. {Cf. 9[32].}
103. {Cf. 9[32].}
105. {Cf. 9 106. {Cf. 9
[104. {Cf. 9[32]
[
[
NOTES TO PAGES 392-403 685
107. 108. 109. . {Cf. olal].} . {Cf. 9f].}
. {Cf. 9[20]; 13[8]; 16[7]; 22[1]_549.}
{Cf. 9[31].} {Cf. 13[8].} {Cf. [21]; 13[8].}
{Cf. 13[7].}
. {Cf. 13[8].}
{Cf. 13[18].}
. {Cf. 16[7].}
{Cf. 16[7].}
dressing and disguises] Kleider und Verkleidung
{Cf. 16[7].}
. {Cf. olis].} . CA. ol]; 13[6].}
. driver and beater] Treiber und Dränger {Hunting terms
that characterize the men who drive the hunted animals into
a
place where they may be killed.}
123.
{Cf. 12[43]; 16[7]; 17148]; 23[5]; 22[1]_553.}
124. {Cf. 16[7].}
126. Collection of sayings and turns of phrase, only some of
which are from earlier notebooks (Notebook 10 = N VI 3 in
par-
ticular); used sparingly for Z II.
127. 128. 129. 130.
131.
132. 133. 134.
135.
136. 137. 138. 139.
{Cf. 13[14]; 16[7].}
{CE£. 10[4]; 13[3]_4034}
{Cf. 13[18]; 16[7].}
686
140.
141.
142.

143.
 144.
 145.
 146.
 147.
 148. 149.
 150. 151. 152. 153. 154.
 {Cf. 10[4]; 13[3]_400.}
 {Cf. ro[r], 16[7].}
 ties up hearts until they shatter] die herzzerschnürende
 {Cf. 10[19]. [19].
 ICH. 10[23]
 [32].
 ICH. 10[33].}
 {Cf. 10[34].}
 binders and tamers] Binder und Bandiger {We read binden
 } } 4 }
 in the sense of "binding and loosing," the power given by
 God.)
 156. you should be given that] {N uses the idiom das soll
 man
 euch zu Ehren sagen, literally, "in all fairness, that
 should be said
 to you." Cf. 10[34].}
 157. 158. 159.
 160.
 161.
 buckets of love] händevoll Liebe
 {Cf. 10[25; 10[35].}
 {Cf. 16[7]; 22[1]_549.}
 Notused for Z.
 that those who create] das den Schaffenden {The verb is
 omitted; the inflection indicates that the worm is doing
 some-
 thing to those who create.}
 fragments; {cf. 9[23]; 13[1]_387-88}.
 163.
 164.
 165.
 166.
 167.
 168. 169. 170.
 {Cf. 35] 49; 9[48]; 12[1] 119; 12[42]; 12[43].}
 (CA. 9[7]; 13[1]_397.)
 {Cf. note to 12[1] 135.}
 {Cf. 12[1] 133; 16[7].}

{Cf. 13[1]_382.}

Like note 162 above.

{Cf. 13[1]_3774}

{Cf. 13[1]_3785 22[1]_549.}

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171. {Cf. 13[1]_378.} 172. {Cf. 13[1]_382.}

173. {Cf. 13[1]_393.}

174. {Cf. 13[1]_393.}

175. {Cf. 4[176]; sl] 254; 5[22]; 12[5]; 16[7]; CW 15, 31[6, 9].}

176. {Cf. 13[3]_402.}

177. {Cf. 13[1]_398.}

179. {Cf. 13[1]_372.}

180. {Cf. 13[1]_374.}

181. {Cf. 13[1]_385.}

182. {Cf. 9[21]; 13[1]_393.}

183. {Cf. 9[20]; 13[1]_393; 16[7]; 22[1]_549.}

184. {Cf. 13[1]_394.}

185. {Cf. 13[1]_395.}

186. {Cf. 13[1]_392.}

187. {Cf. 5[r]; 12[1]_138; BGE 81.}

188. {Cf. 3[1]_170; 12[1]_106.}

189. {Cf. 3[1]_138 and corresponding note; 12[1]_107.}

190. {Cf. 3[l] 273; 12[1]_99; 16[7]; CW 15, 31[36]; 32[9].}

191. {Cf. 3[1]_394; 12[1]_89.}

192. {Cf. 475, 279]; 5[21].}

194. {Cf. 12[43]; 13[1]_373.}

195. {Cf. 10[22].}

196. {Cf. 13[1]_381].}

Overcoming."

198. {Cf. 12[1]_160.}

199. {Cf. 4167, 79].}

201. {Cf. 9[30]; 13[1]_375.}

202. {Cf. si] 227}

203. {Cf. 12[12].}

204. {Cf. 13[1]_397.}

205. {Cf. 13[1]_382; 16[7]; 17[58]; 22[1]_551-}

206. {Cf. 13[1]_379.}

688

207. 208. 209.

210. 211.

212. 213. 214. 215.

216. 217. 218. 219.

220.

221.

222.

223.
 224.
 225.
 226.
 227.
 228. 229.
 230. 231. 232. 233.
 234.
 235. 236. 237. 238. 239.
 240.
 241.
 242.
 {Cf. 9l]; 13[1] 373.}
 {Cf. ol]; 13[1]_3715 16[4]; 22[1].}
 {Cf. 13[1]_379.}
 Like note 162 above.
 {Cf. 13[1]_379; 16[7]; 22[1]_550.}
 {Cf. 9[24]; 13[1]_386.}
 {Cf. ol]: 3] 376].}
 {Cf. 9[23]; 13[1]_386.}
 {Cf. 9[18], 13[1] ; 16[7].}
 {Cf. 9[17]; 131] -390.}
 {Cf. 9[17]; 13[1]_390.}
 {Cf. 3[1] 80; 5[35]s 1201] 53.}
 Like note 162 above; {cf. 10[36]}.
 {Cf. 10[36].}
 {Cf. 13[]_387.}
 {Cf. 11[16].}
 Like note 162 above.
 {Cf. 13[1]_372.}
 {Cf. 13[1]_384; 13[10]; 16[7]; 22[1]_550.} {Cf. 13[3];
 16[7].}
 {Cf. 3[1] 300; 12[1] 146.}
 {Cf. 1[59] 3[1] 13; 4[226]; 12i] 147; 16[7].}
 {Cf. 3i] 328; 12i] 148; 16[7].}
 {Cf. 13[11]_377.}
 {Cf. 111s].}
 Like note 162 above; {cf. 9[24]; 13[1]_386}.
 {Cf. 3[1] 124; 5[1] 209; 12[15].}
 Like note 162 above.
 {Cf. 13[]_373.}
 {Cf. 13[1]_391.}
 {Cf. 10[38]; 13[1]_374.}
 {Cf. 10[38]; 13[1]_374-}
 {Cf. 12[1] 103.}
 {Cf. 3[1] 243; 12[1] 101; 16[7]; 23[5]; BGE 99.}

{Cf. 30] 349; 12[1] 90; 16[7]; BGE 169.}
 Like note 162 above; {cf. 13[1]_398}.
 {Cf. 13[1]_392.}
 NOTES TO PAGES 418-427 689
 244. {Cf. 4[160]; 5[1] 247; 12[6].}
 246. {Cf. 9[19]; 13[1]; 16[7].}
 247. {Cf. 13[1]_394.}
 248. {Cf. 13[3, 18]; 16[7].}
 249. {Cf. 3[1] 342; 12[1] 94.}
 250. old wives] alte Weiber {Translated here as "wives" because
 of the connection in English to "old wives' tales."}
 251. young and female] junge Weibchen
 252. {Cf. 10[1].}
 254. {Cf. 13[29, 31].}
 255. {Cf. 13[1]_382.}
 256. {Cf. 3[1] 287; 4[42, 200]; 12[1] 96.}
 258. {Cf. 9[32].}
 259. {Cf. 9[14, 36, 56]; 13[1]_396; 13[20].}
 260. {Cf. 9[4]; 13[1]_382.}
 ZU.
 Sicily.}
 265. {Cf. 13[1]_383.}
 690 NOTES TO PAGES 428-437
 [14 = M III 2b]
 1 Cf. 7[268].
 2. impetus] "passions" {This is the Latin plural, not our
 English
 translation.}
 [15 =N VIs]
 1. The writings of this notebook constitute an attempt that
 N
 abandoned to continue his Zarathustra work after the completion
 of Z II with a third and a fourth part; these writings
 were
 given little attention later during the writing of Z III.
 2. notto... of life!] {Cf. BGE 4.}
 4. {Cf. Sir Walter Scott, The Monastery: A Romance (1820)
 and
 The Abbot (1820), a sequel to The Monastery.
 5s. {Cf. Joseph Haller, Altspanische Sprichwörter und
 sprichwörtliche Redensarten aus den Zeiten vor Cervantes
 ("Old
 Spanish proverbs and proverbial phrases from the times before
 Cervantes") (Regensburg: Manz, 1883).}

6. {Cf. Wilhelm Leopold Colmar Freiherr von der Goltz, Das Volk in Waffen: Ein Buch über Heerwesen und Kriegführung unserer

Zeit ("The People in arms: A book on military affairs and warfare

of our time") (Berlin: Decker, 1883). NL}

7. {Cf. 16[86]; 22[1]_546.}

8. {Cf. 22[1]_546.}

9. suspends... in favor] aufhebt

10. {Cf. 16[86].}

11. agon] "contest," "struggle"

12. ancestry] Herkunft

13. Emerson p. 237.] N refers to the following passage in Ver-

suche (Essays), {trans. G. Fabricius (Hanover: Carl Meyer, 1858),

NL; originally published in English as The Collected Works of

Ralph Waldo Emerson, vol. 2: Essays, First Series, ed. Alfred Riggs

Ferguson, Joseph Slater, and Jean Ferguson Carr (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 1971), 190}: "The one thing which

we seek with insatiable desire is to forget ourselves, to be sur-

prised out of our propriety, to lose our sempiternal memory, and

to do something without knowing how or why; in short, to draw

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a new circle. Nothing great was ever achieved without enthusiasm.

The way of life is wonderful: it is by abandonment. The great moments of history are the facilities of performance through the strength of ideas, as the works of genius and religion.

'A man, said Oliver Cromwell, 'never rises so high as when he

knows not whither he is going.' Dreams and drunkenness, the use of opium and alcohol are the semblance and counterfeit of

this oracular genius, and hence their dangerous attraction for

men. For the like reason, they ask the aid of wild passions, as in

gaming and war, to ape in some manner these flames and gen-

er-
osities of the heart." {Although KSA 14 notes that the Crom-
well
quote "was underlined by N," this is not in fact correct;
although
the entire page was repeatedly highlighted, these particular
lines
are uniquely highlighted by seven marginal lines.} On Crom-
well's quote, cf. SE 1, CW 2, 174.
14. then you must bring them up, bring them up to you! so
mußt du erziehen, zu Dir hinauf ziehen! {N's wordplay is on erzie-
hen, meaning "to raise" or "to educate."}
15. {These lines were copied by N from Wilhelm Leopold Col-
mar Freiherr von der Goltz, "Feldherren und Feldherrenthum"
("Field marshals and their domain"), Deutsche Rundschau 31
(April-
June 1882): 378-402.}
16. rooted in the earth] wachse aus der Erde
17. {Cf. *ibid.*, 390; said about Alexander}
18. {Cf. *ibid.*, 399; the quote is from Thomas Carlyle,
Geschichte
Friedrichs II: Von Preußen, genannt Friedrich der Große
(History of
Friedrich II of Prussia, Called Frederick the Great), first
published
in English in 1858 (the sentence quoted appears in vol. 4,
p. 168),
trans. J. Neuberger (Berlin: Verlag der Königlichen Geheimen
Oberhofbuchdr., 1866), 178: "Ich will es vollbringen oder
ster-
ben!" ("I will achieve it or die!").}
19. {Cf. Goltz, "Feldherren und Feldherrenthum," 387; the
quote is from Aristotle: "Der Zorn ist notwendig, ohne ihn
tri-
umphiert man in Nichts" ("Anger is necessary, without it
there is
no victory"). Cf. Seneca, *De ira* ("On anger") 1.9.2: "Ira,
inquit
Aristoteles, necessaria est, nec quidquam sine illa expug-
nari
potest." English translation: "On Anger," in Seneca, *Moral
and
692 NOTES TO PAGES 440-441*
Political Essays, ed. and trans. John M. Cooper and J. F.
Procopé

(Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1995), 27: "Anger," says Aristotle, "is needful; no fight can be won with it."}

20. {Cf. Goltz, "Feldherren und Feldherrenthum," 388; the quote is from Carl von Clausewitz, *Vom Kriege* (Berlin: Dümmlers Verlag, 1832), 4: "in so gefährlichen Dingen, wie der Krieg eins ist, sind die Irrthümer, welche aus Gutmüthigkeit entstehen, gerade die schlimmsten." English translation: *On War*, trans. Michael Howard and Peter Paret (Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press, 1984), 75: "war is such a dangerous business that the mistakes which come from kindness are the very worst."}

21. {Cf. Goltz, "Feldherren und Feldherrenthum," 383.}

22. {Cf. *ibid.*, 384; the quote is attributed to Tamerlane: "Wie klein ist diese Erde für den Ehrgeiz eines großen Fürsten" ("This earth is too small for the ambition of a great prince").}

23. measure] Verdienst

24. {Cf. *ibid.*; cf. also Theobald Chauber, *Friedrich der Große, König von Preussen: Sein Leben und Wirken* (Stuttgart: Scheible's, 1834), 277: "Das wahre Verdienst eines Fürsten besteht in der aufrichtigen Neigung zum allgemeinen Besten in seiner Liebe zum Vaterlande und zum Ruhm" ("The true merit of a prince consists in the sincere affection for the general good in his love of country and glory").}

25. {Cf. Goltz, "Feldherren und Feldherrenthum," 386.}

26. {Cf. *ibid.*, 379-83.}

27. {Cf. *ibid.*, 382, where this remark is attributed to Alcibiades.}

28. {Cf. *ibid.*, where this remark is attributed to Xenophon.}

29. {Cf. *ibid.*, 383, where this remark is attributed to Napoleon in reference to war. Cf. Bruno Colson, ed., *Napoleon on War*, trans. Gregory Elliott (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2015), 126: "in war, morale and opinion are more than half of real-

ity."}

30. {Cf. Goltz, "Feldherren und Feldherrenthum," 380.}

31. {Cf. *ibid.*; this remark is taken from Napoleon's letter of 26

September 1797 to the Minister of Foreign Affairs: "Tous les grands événements ne tiennent jamais qu'à un

cheveu." (Corres-

pondance de Napoleon I^{er}: Publiée par ordre de l'empereur Napo-

l^{éon} III (Paris: 1859], 3:342).}

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32. {Cf. Goltz, "Feldherren und Feldherrenthum," in reference to the Prophet Mohammed.}

33. is stewing in his own juices] in seinem eigenen Saft kochen

{Or literally, "to boil in one's own juice."}

34. {Cf. JS 341}

36. To know] erkennen {Cf. the Translators' Afterword, 739-40,

on the rendering of *wissen* and *erkennen*.}

37. mimicry] {In English in the original. N is almost certainly

referring to British naturalist Alfred Russel Wallace (1823-1913),

who discussed mimicry in animals as a form of "protective resemblance."

Cf. D 26; TI "Forays" 14.}

39. {Cf. Eduard von Hartmann, *Gesammelte Studien und Aufsätze*

gemeinverständlichen Inhalts ("Collected studies and essays for a

more general audience") (Berlin: Duncker, 1876).}

40. {Cf. Leopold von Ranke, *Die römischen Päpste, ihre Kirche*

und ihr Staat im sechszehnten und siebzehnten Jahrhundert ("The

Roman popes, their church and their state in the sixteenth and

seventeenth centuries"), 3 vols. (Berlin: Duncker und Humblot,

1834-36).}

41. {Cf. Julius Wellhausen, *Prolegomena zur Geschichte Israels*

("Prolegomena to the history of Israel"), 2nd ed. (Berlin: Reimer,

1883). NL.}

42. {Cf. Eugen Dreher, *Der Darwinismus und seine Consequenzen in wissenschaftlicher und socialer Beziehung* ("Darwinism and

its consequences in relation to science and society")

(Halle: Pfeffer-

fer, 1882). NL; *Ton und Wort mit Bezugnahme auf das Musik-Drama R. Wagners* ("Tone and word with reference to the musical drama of R. Wagner") (Halle: Pfeffer, 1880).}

43. {Cf. Jeremy Bentham, *Grundsätze der civil- und criminal-gesetzgebung* ("Principles of civil and criminal legislation"), Ger-

man trans. by Friedrich Eduard Beneke (Berlin: C. F. Amelang,

1830) of *Traité de législation civile et pénale*, ed. and trans. Etienne

Dumont (Paris: Bossange, Masson, et Besson, 1802).}

44. {Hendrik Kern, *Der Buddhismus und seine Geschichte in Indien: Eine Darstellung der Buddhistischen Kirche* ("Buddhism

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and its history in India: A presentation of the Buddhist church"),

2 vols., trans. from Dutch by Hermann Jacobi (Leipzig: Schulze,

1882, 1884).}

(16 = Z II 1a.)

1. Plan for a Zarathustra drama (after the completion of ZI).

2. Collection of sayings and turns of phrase, drawn completely from earlier notebooks, especially 9, 10, and 13.

3. {Cf. 90}; 13[1] _371; 13[11]; 22[1]_548.}

4. {Cf. 9l}; 13l _372; 22[1]_549.}

5. {Cf. olis}; 10[17]; 13[1]_372.} 6. {Cf. 13[1]_373;

22[1]_548.} 7. {Cf. 13[]_376; 22[1]_549.} 8. {Cf. 13[1]_377;

22[1]_549.} 9. {Cf. 13[1]_378; 22[1]_549.} 10. {Cf.

13[1]_378; 22[1]_549.}

u. A later addition from early 1888.

12. Like 16[4]. 13. {Cf. 13[1]_379; 22[1]_sso.} 14. {Cf.

13[1]_379; 13[12]; 22[1]_550.} 15. {Cf. 9[6]; 13[1]_380;

22[1]_550.} 16. {Cf. 13[1]_381; 22[1]_549.}

17. {Cf. 13[1]_382; 13[11]; 17[58]; 22[1]_551.}

18. {Cf. 13[1]_383; 13l, 14]; 22[1]_550.}

19. {Cf. 13[1]_384; 22[1]_549.} 20. {Cf. 13[1]_388;

22[1]_549.} 21. {Cf. 9[18]; 13[1]_389; 22[1]_s.}

22. {Cf. 9[18]; 13[1]_389; 22[1]_550.}

23. {Cf. ol18], 13[1]_389; 13l12].} 24. {Cf. 9[19];
13[1]_390; 13[18].} 25. {Cf. 9[i]3 13[1]_390; 22[1]_549.}
26. {Cf. 9[20]; 13[1]_393; 138]; 22[1]_549.}
27. {Cf. 13[1]_394.} 28. {Cf. 3l]_394.} 29. {Cf. 13[1]_395.}
30. {Cf. 12 [43]; 13[1]_397; 17148]; 2315]; 22[1]_553.}
31. {Cf 13[1]_397}

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32. {Cf. 13[3]_399; 13[14].}
33. {Cf. 13[3]_400; 13[18].}
34. {Cf. rolr], 13[3]_405.}
35. {Cf 13[3]_407; 22[]_549.}
36. {Cf. 3l1] 243; 12[1] 101; 13[16]; 23[5]; CW 15, 31135,
36]; 32[10];
38. {Cf. 1[59]; 3l1] i 4[226]; 12[1] 147; 13[14].}
39. {Cf. 3[1] 328; 12[1] 148; 13[14].}
40. {Cf. 3[1] 273; 12[1] 99; 13[8].}
41. {Cf. 4[176]; si) 2543 5[22]; 1215]; 13[7]; CW 15, 3116,
9].}
42. {Cf. 12[1] 133; 13[6].}
43. {Cf. 22[1]_547}
44. Draft of a plan before the completion of Z III; in con-
junc-
tion with this, see the plans and drafts 21[1-6].
46. {Cf. alu]; sl1] 176; 5l17]; 22[3]_563.}
7. "they... life"] Cf. BT 7.
Hartmann's Philosophie des Unbewussten ("Philosophy of the
Unconscious").}
49. "pessimist of the intellect."] According to J. Burck-
hardt's
Definition der Griechen ("Definition of the Greeks"), cf. CW
12,
5[70] and accompanying note; {cf. MM 11, CW 4, 16}.
so. "what... honor.] Cf. MM 26, CW 4, 21.
s1. Cf. 22[1]{_547}.
53. history of origins] Entstehungs-Geschichte
54. {Cf SE 5, CW 2, 214, lines 25-28.}
56. origin] Herkommen {Also later in this fragment}
Empfindungen (Chemnitz{: Schmeitzner,} 1877), NL. {Trans-
lated
by Robin Small as The Origin of the Moral Sensations, in
Paul
Rée, Basic Writings, ed. Robin Small (Urbana: University of
Illli-
nois Press, 2003): 81-167.}
696 NOTES TO PAGES 454-461
59. {Cf. Rée, "The Origin of the Moral Sensations," 114:

"But
 if nothing in the punishments carried out reminds one that
 they
 are a means of deterrence for the future, it must come to
 seem
 that they are a retribution for the past."}
 60. {Cf. *ibid.*, 115: "Actions that are necessary cannot be
 sub-
 jected either to attribution of responsibility or to retri-
 bution for
 what has occurred."}
 61. Will-o-the-wisp] Irrlicht {Phantom lights engendered by
 decaying plants in swamps and wetlands, associated in myth
 with beings that lead travelers astray}
 63. {WP 760}
 Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins: Prolegomena zu
 jeder
 künftigen Ethik ("Phenomenology of moral consciousness:
 Prole-
 gomena to any future ethics") (Berlin: Duncker, 1879), 646.
 NL.}
 65. {WP 769.}
 70. competition . . . intellect] {WP 613.}
 73. As in 16[8]; the same is true without exception for the
 frag-
 ments that immediately follow, all the way to the end:
 16[38-90].
 74. N is referring to the following passage in Emerson's
 Ver-
 suche {Essays: Second Series, "Politics"}: "To educate the
 wise man,
 the State exists; and with the appearance of the wise man,
 the
 State expires. The appearance of character makes the State
 un-
 necessary. The wise man is the State. He needs no army,
 fort, or
 navy, — he loves men too well; no bribe, or feast, or
 palace, to
 draw friends to him; no vantage ground, no favorable circum-
 stance. He needs no library, for he has not done thinking;
 no
 church, for he is a prophet; no statute book, for he has the
 law-
 giver; no money, for he is value; no road, for he is at home
 where

he is; no experience, for the life of the creator shoots
 through
 him, and looks from his eyes. He has no personal friends,
 for he
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 who has the spell to draw the prayer and piety of all men
 unto
 him, needs not husband and educate a few, to share with him
 a
 select and poetic life. His relation to men is angelic; his
 memory
 is myrrh to them; his presence, frankincense and
 flowers." {Much
 of this} excerpt was underlined by N, the entire passage
 high-
 lighted several times.
 75. completely in harmony with the truth] vollkommen der
 Wahrheit {We attempt to capture the strangeness of the
 phrasing.}
 76. {Cf. 7[238].}
 77. {Cf. 22[1]_547.}
 78. {Cf. the third movement of Beethoven's penultimate
 string
 quartet (String Quartet No. 15 in A Minor, Op. 132), sub-
 titled
 "Heiliger Dankgesang eines Genesenden an die Got-
 theit" ("Holy
 Song of Thanksgiving to the Deity from a Convalescent").}
 79. Beatitude] Seligpreisung {A reference to the Beatitudes
 in
 the Sermon on the Mount (Matthew 5:3-11).}
 80. sub specie aeterni] "under the aspect of the etern-
 al" {That is,
 in its essential or eternal form. Phrase associated with
 Spinoza.}
 81. unified by power] Einheit des { ...} in der Macht {The
 inflec-
 tion makes it clear that all three groups are included.}
 82. {Cf. 16[59, 84]; 21[3]; 22[1]_547}
 83. {Cf. 16[59, 84]; 21[3]; 22[1]_5474
 84. ripeness and tenderness] Reife und Mürbe {We use "ripe-
 ness"
 and "tenderness" here instead of the more conventional
 transla-
 tions "maturity" and "mellowing" in order to maintain N's
 botan-

ical analogy.}

85. exuberance] Übermuth

86. {Cf. 16[50]; 21[3]; 22[1]_547.}

87. Zarathustra... nothing else!] {An allusion to Luther's remark
in Worms: "Here I stand. I can do nothing else."}

88. Determinism] {N uses the English term here, and the German term Determinismus below.}

89. fatum] "fate," "one's lot" {N here underlines the Latin fatum.}

90. that can't be missing] die nicht fehlen darf

91. audience] die Empfänger

93. {WP 974.}

94. {Cf. 17[29]; 22[3]_623.}

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95. {Cf. 17[29]; 18[4]; old); 22[1]_548; 22[1]_562.}

96. {Cf. 16[50, 59]; 22[1]_547}

97. {Cf. 17[29].}

98. {Cf. Gustav Teichmüller, Neue Studien zur Geschichte der Begriffe, Heft 3: Die praktische Vernunft bei Aristoteles ("New studies
on the history of concepts, vol. 3: Practical reason according to
Aristotle") (Gotha: Perthes, 1879); Teichmüller mentions "selfish-
ness" on p. 130, not 131.}

99. {Cf. 17[27].}

100. {Cf. 17[27, 29, 40].}

ror. {Cf. 15[21].}

102. {Cf. 15[18]; 22[1]_546.}

103. {Cf. 15[18]; 22[1]_546.}

104. {Cf. 22[1]_545.}

105. {Cf. 3[1] 25; 4[31]; 16[88]; 18[24]; 22[1]_546; BGE 132.}

106. teach about the superhumans] den Übermenschen lehren {Cf.
4[208] and 5[8], where "superhumans" are also the subject matter}

107. {Cf. 10[3].}

[17 =N VI 6.]

2. huckster-virtues] Krämer-Tugenden {We have chosen the term "huckster" for Krämer because the usual term, "shop-keeper,"
is not pejorative enough to capture N's meaning.}

3. money-grubbing] geldklebrige

5. they all deserve each other] sie sind alle einander wert

{Cf.
 17[9]; 18[19]; 22[2].}
 6. {Cf. 22[1]_555.}
 9. {Cf. 22[1]_556.}
 10. {Cf. 22[1]_556.}
 u. Cf. 22[5]_573.
 12. mortar] Mörser {As in mortar and pestle, here used for
 mix-
 ing herbs, as opposed to "on a bible or altar."}
 3. {Cf. 4[17]}
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 14. . {Cf 22[1]_561.}
 16.
 Arrangement predates the composition of Z III.
 . {Cf. 17[2]; 18[19]; 22[2].} . {Cf. 22[1]_562; 22[2].}
 the way I wish] wie ich Lust habe {We here deviate from the
 usual
 rendering of Lust ("desire" or "pleasure") to preserve the
 wordplay}
 20.
 21.
 22. 23. 24.
 25.
 26.
 27.
 {Cf. 22[1]_561.}
 {Cf. 17[10, 26]; 22[1]_556; 22[1]_560.}
 {Cf. 22[1]_560.}
 Cf. 22[2].
 {Cf. 22[1]_560.}
 Cf. 22[1]{_560}.
 {Except for the second phrase, cf. 22[3]_567.}
 {Cf. 22[3]_565.}
 29. firm] hart {We chose the equivalent adjective for "hand-
 shake" in English.}
 30.
 {Cf. Matthew 19:14; Mark 10:14; Luke 18:16. For the next
 three phrases, cf. 22[3]_567.}
 31.
 44
 {Cf 22[3]_565.}
 . {For the next four fragments, cf. 22[3]_566}
 . {For the next five fragments, cf. 22[3]_565.}
 . {Cf. 17[15]; 22[3]_565; 22[3]_569.}
 . {Cf. 20[12]; 22[3]_565.}
 . {Cf. 22[3]_568.}

. {Cf. 22[3]_568.}

. {Cf 22[3]_568.}

. {For the final three fragments, cf. 22[3]_568.}

. aloneness] Alleinsein

. {Cf. 17[14]; 17[15]; 22[3]_569.}

. So why, then, . . . dreaming.] Cf. Z III "The Wanderer."

. Cf. Z III "The Wanderer"; {17[14]; 22[3]_569}.

. Cf. 22[3, 5] {Included in this fragment are a series of clever phrases and wordplay, some of which are repeated or revised in later notebooks.}

45.

{Cf 22[3]_569.}

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46. {Cf. 17[17]; 18[12]; 22[5].}

47. {Cf. 20[12]; 22[5].}

48. {Cf. 17[20]; 22[5].}

49. entertain others] ihnen Unterhaltung schaffen {The word-play is between Unterhaltung ("entertainment") and Unterhalt ("liveliness").}

50. "by accident] "von Ohngefähr"

51. {Cf. 20[12]; 22[5].}

53. {Cf. 17[16]; 18[2]; 22[5].}

56. {Cf. 18[46]; 22[3]_571.}

57. {Cf. 17[16]; 22[5].}

58. {Cf. 17[25, 56]; 18[34]; 22[1]_5525 22[5]_5733 22[5]_574.}

60. {N here alludes to the opening scene of Wagner's Siegfried (first performed in Bayreuth 16 August 1876), where the hero asks his foster father Mime: "Wer is mir Vater und Mutter?" ("Who are father and mother to me?").}

62. {Cf. 22[4].}

63. {Cf. 18[18]; 22[5].}

66. {Cf. 17[20, 56]; 18[34]; 22[1]_5523 22[5]_57% 22[5]_574} II; {cf. 17[10]; 22[1]_556; 22[1]_so}.

71. {Cf. 16[84].}

72. {Cf. 16[84]; 17[29].}

73. {Cf. 16[84]; 17[27, 40].}

74. {Cf. 16[84]; 18[4]; zoli; 22[1]_548; 22[1]_556.}

75. {Cf. zol; 22[1]_548.}

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76. {Cf. 17[48]; 20[1]; 22[1 547].}

77. finger] Zehe {We switch from "toe" to "finger" to render the idiom.}

79. {Cf. 1[19, 22].}

Z III; cf. also the plans in Group 21.

81. {Cf 22[1]_557.}

84. {Cf. 22[1]_557.}

85. {Cf. Herbert Spencer, *Die Thatsachen der Ethik* (The Data of Ethics, part 1 of vol. 1 of *The Principles of Ethics*), trans. Benja-
min Vetter (Stuttgart: Schweizerbart, 1879), 269. NL}

89. akrasia] "weakness of will"

go. Cf. 22[1]{_557}.

92. {Cf. Ralph Waldo Emerson, *Versuche* (Essays), trans. G. Fabricius (Hanover: Carl Meyer, 1858), NL; "Manners," in *The Collected Works of Ralph Waldo Emerson*, vol. 3: *Essays*, Second
Series (Cambridge, MA: Belknap Press of Harvard University Press, 1983), 89–90.}

93. {Cf. 19[5]; 20[10].}

94. enjoyment of self abolishing] Selbst-Aufhebung-Genuff
{See our
notes on *Aufhebung* in the Translators' Afterword, 738; cf. 20[10].}

96. {Cf. 20[r].}

97. {Cf. 22[1]_557.}

99. {Cf. 22[1]_557.}

ror. Like 17[2].

102. to fall apart] zu Grunde gehn

702

104.

105.

106.

107.

108.

II.

112. 113.

114.

{Cf. 22[3]_565.}

Cf. 22[1]{_557}.

{Cf. 12[43]; 13[1]_397; 16[7]; 22[1]553; 23[5].}

{Cf. 17[130]; 20[1]; 22[1]_5474}

{Cf. 22[1]_553.}

Cf. note to 7[17].

{Cf. 22[1]_552.}

{Cf. 17[52, 60]; 18[1]; 20[9]; 22[1 557.]}

Like 17[2]; cf. 22[1] {_552}.

Like 17[2] and 117[18].

{Cf. 17[50, 60]; 18[1]; 20[9]; 22[1]_557.}

Moravians] Herrnhuter {The Moravian Church or Unitas Fratrum had a threefold ideal of faith, fellowship, and freedom, and a strong emphasis on practical Christian life rather than on doctrine or tradition. First founded at the end of the sixteenth century, it experienced revival under the leadership of Nikolaus Ludwig, Count Zinzendorf, in the town of Herrnhut in Saxony in the eighteenth century.}

116.

117. 118. 119.

123.

124.

125.

126.

127.

Like 17[9]; ef. 22[1]{_552}. Cf. 22[1]{_552}.

. {Cf. 17[20, 25]; 18[134]; 22[1]_552; 22[5]_573; 22[15]_574-}

. {Cf. 10[8, 35]; 22[1]_552.} . {Cf 22[1]_552.}

Cf. 17[18].

Cf. 22[1]{_ssi}.

{Cf. 13[1]_382; 13[11]; 16[7]; 22[1]_551.}

Cf. 22[1]{_5513 17167}; 20[9]}.

Cf. {20[9] (characteristics of friendship)}; 22[1]{_557}-

{Cf. 17[50, 52]; 18[1]; 20[9]; 22[1]_557}

your] seinen {We use the second-person form to convey the context of advice; cf. 20[9]; 22[1]_557.}

130.

131. 132. Like 17[9].

Cf. 22[1]{_557}. Cf. 22[1]{_554}.

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134. novelty] Neugierde {Cf. Grimm 13:656-57.}

138. {Cf. 17[59]; 20[9]; 22[1]_551-}

139. in his supreme right] an sein höheres Recht {This could also refer to the supreme right of the people.}

140. {Cf. 22[1]_554.}

141. Concerning a third and fourth part dating before the composition of Z III.

142. {Cf. 22[1]_560.}

143. {Cf. 20[9].}

147. {Cf. Mark 10:14.}

148. {Cf. 22[1]_558}; N's term is Händler, which means "merchants." We try to preserve the wordplay on Handel's name here.}

149. In this book, Auguste Blanqui argued for a notion close to thoughts of eternal return of the same; cf. Henri Lichtenberger, *Die Philosophie Friedrich Nietzsches*, {trans. into German from the French by Elisabeth Förster-Nietzsche (Dresden and Leipzig{: Carl Reissner,} 1899), 204-9.

150. {Cf. Louis-Auguste Blanqui, *L'éternité par les astres* (Paris: Librairie Germer Baillière, 1872); translated by Frank Chouraqui as *Eternity by the Stars* (New York: Contra Mundum Press, 2013).}

1st. Cf. 22[1] {_558}.

152. {Cf. 22[1]_558.}

154. {Cf. 22[1]_558.}

155. future generations] die zukünftigen Menschen

156. women] Frauen {N uses Weiber in 18[15, 23]; 22[1]_558; 23[3].}

158. obsession . . . hits home] {We try here to re-create N's wordplay with Sucht ("obsession"), mein Heim suchen ("sought . . . my home"), and Heimsuchung ("hit home").}

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159. Cf. 22[1]{_559}. 160. {Cf. Exodus 33:3.} 161. Cf. 22[1]{_559}. 162. {Cf. 22[1]_559.}

{18 = N VI 7.}

i Cf. 22[3]{_570}.

2. "God is not] "es ist kein Gott {Here as in 22[3], N varies his usual phrase es gibt keinen Gott ("there is no God"). The meaning is essentially the same.}

3. {Cf. 17[50, 52, 60]; 20[9]; 22[1]_557.}

4. {Cf. 20[14].}

6. {Cf. 17[16, 17]; 22[5].}

7. {Cf. 16[84]; 17[29]; 20[1]; 22[1]_548; 22[1]_556.}

8. that's where the spice is] hier ist der Pfeffer {Literally, "here is the pepper."}

10. {Cf. 17[78]; 18[23]; 22[1]_558; 23[3].}
 u. rasped] röchelte
 12. {Cf. 17[22]; 22[5].}
 14. {Cf. 13[3]_402.}
 15. {Cf. 17[78]; 18[15]; 22[1]_558; 23[3].}
 16. in the family way] gesegneten Leibes {A "proper" euphemism
 for pregnancy.}
 17. {Cf. 3[1] 25; 4[31]; 16[88]; 22[1]_546; BGE 132.}
 21. {Cf. 17[20, 25, 56]; 22[1]_5523 22[5]_571; 22[5]_574.}
 23. word] das Wort {"Word" has the dual meaning in English
 of "individual word" and "saying."}
 24. {Cf. 18[57, 59].}
 25. sealing] Besiegelung
 26. {Cf. 3l1] 245; 4[165]; 11[8]; 18[49, 56]; 21[6];
 24[16].}

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28. loving refreshment] Liebsal {A pun on the German Labsal,
 meaning "refreshment."}
 30. Bible-thumpers] Betbrüder {We think "Bible-thumpers" is
 the closest equivalent; cf. 17[20]; 22[3]_571.}
 31. {Cf 22[1]_554.}
 33. {Cf. 30] 245; 4l165]; 11[8]; 18[43, 56]; 21[6]; 24[16].}
 34. Ich fand aufmeinem Gange seine langen Esels-Ohren – ich
 fand auch meine Schlange, die hatte den Kopf verloren.
 36. junkyard dog] Kettenhund {Literally "dog on a chain."}
 37. {Cf. 3l1] 245; 4l165]; 11[8]; 18[43, 49]; 21l]; 24[16].}
 38. {Cf. 18[38, 59].}
 {19 = N VI 8}
 1. to break] zerbrechen {Consistent with the wording in Exo-
 dus 32:19, KJ V.}
 . Cf. Z III "On Apostates."
 . Cf. Z III "On Old and New Tablets."
 . {Cf. 17[39]; 20[r].}
 . Cf. ZIV "The Sign."
 . Arrangement of Z III.
 . Cf. Z III "The Convalescent."
 9. rasp] réchelst {Has connotations of a death rattle.}
 u. Cf. 16[49]; 21[3].
 12. my soul, the prophet] meine Seele, die Wahrsagerin {The fem-
 inine inflection does not necessarily indicate that N thinks of
 the soul as female, so we have not translated Wahrsagerin as
 "prophetess."}
 CON AM A WwW

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(20 = Z II 2,)

2. {Cf. 170, 48}; 22[1]_547.}

3. {Cf. 17[30]; 22[1]_547.}

4. {Cf. 16[84]; 18[4]; 22[1]_548; 22[1]_556.}

7. tartuffery] Tartufferie {From the character in Molière's Tar-
tuffe (1664).}

8. {Cf. Herbert Spencer, Einleitung in das Studium der Soci-
olo-
gie ("Introduction to the study of sociology"), ed. Heinrich Mar-
quardsen (Leipzig: Brockhaus, 1875), 2:110. NL.}

9. abolition] Aufhebung

Neue Studien zur Geschichte der Begriffe, Heft 3: Die prakt-
ische

Vernunft bei Aristoteles ("New studies on the history of
concepts,

vol. 3: Practical reason according to Aristotle") (Gotha:
Perthes,
1879).}

u. {Cf. *ibid.*, 65.}

12. "The courageous... done"] {Cf. *ibid.*, 76.}

1s. {Cf. 17[59, 67]; 22[1]_551.}

16. {Cf. 17[60]; 22[1]_557.}

17. {Cf. 17[50, 52, 60]; 18[1]; 22[1]_558.}

19. {Cf. 17[40].}

20. {Cf. 17[39].}

22. you my necessity] {Here Zarathustra's invocation "Du
meine

Notwendigkeit" ("You my necessity") recalls and inverts
Sieg-

fried's invocation to his sword Notung in act 1, scene 3 of
Wag-

ner's opera. N also puns on Wende ("cusp") and Noth-
wendigkeit

("necessity").}

24. {Cf. 17[16]; 22[5].}

25. {Cf. 17[13]; 22[3]_565.}

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27. toy trum peters] Schnurrpfeifer {Flügel 847 defines
Schnurr-

pfeifel Schnurrpfeiferei as a vulgar term for frivolous or
meaning-

less things or activities, here a reference to the abysmal
quality of

their message.}
 28. {Cf. 18[1].}
 [21 = Mp XV 3b]
 2. temptation] Versuchung {This could also be rendered as
 "experiment."}
 4. {Cf. 16[50, 59, 84]; 22[1]_547.}
 5. order] der Orden {In the sense of a fraternity or reli-
 gious
 order.}
 7. {Cf. 3l₁ 245; 4[165]; 11[8]; 18[43, 49, 56]; 24[16].}
 8. bien public] "public good," something available for the com-
 mon good (e.g., clean air).
 9. {N noted the link between socialism, Jesuitism, and eu-
 dai-
 monistic ethics in Eduard von Hartmann's Phänomenologie des
 sittlichen Bewusstseins: Prolegomena zu jeder künftigen
 Ethik (Berlin:
 C. Duncker, 1879), 649-50. NL}
 10. actions] Handeln {N means "acting" here, as in engaging
 in
 activity or action.}
 [22 = Z II 3a.)
 1. Revised copy from the earlier notebooks (13, 15, 16, 17,
 18)
 containing sayings and turns of phrase that were adopted in
 part
 for ZII.
 2. {Cf. 16[88].}
 3. {Cf. 3[1] 25; 4[31]; 16[88]; 18[24]; BGE 132.}
 4. {Cf. 15[18]; 16[86].}
 5. {Cf. 15[18]; 16[86].}
 6. {Cf. 16[50, 59, 84]; 21[3].}
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 so
 3. {Cf. 17[32].} 14. {Cf. 17[30]; 20l₁.}
 15. {Cf. 17[30, 48]; 20l₁.}
 16. {Cf. 20[r]; 22[1]_547.}
 17. {Cf. 16[84]; 17[29]; 18[4]; 2011]; 22[1]_548.}
 19. coincidence] Zufall {Here N adds the modifier jeden
 ("every"),
 our shift from "chance" to "coincidence" refers to a single
 instance}
 20. {Cf. 0l₁; 13[1]_373; 13[11]; 16[4].}
 21. {Cf. 13[1]_373; 16[4].} 22. {Cf. 13[3]; 16[7].} 23. {Cf
 Bi 378; 16[4].}

[3 [24. {Cf 30)]. 25. {Cf. a 16[4]. 26. {Cf. 13[1]_378;
 16[4]. 27. {Cf. glas]; 13[1]_3725 16[4].}
 28. {Cf. 13[1] 384; al 7}
 29. {Cf. 13[1]_381; 16[7].} 30. {Cf. 13[1]_388; 16[7].} 31.
 {Cf. 9[19]; 13[1]_390; 16[7].}
 32. {Cf. 9[20]; 13[1]_393; 13[8]; 16[7].}
 33. {Cf. 13[1] 379; 16[7].}
 34. {Cf. 13[1] 379; 13[12]; 16[7].}
 35. {Cf. 13[1]_383; 13[10, 14]; 16[
 36. {Cf. 9[6]; 13[1]_380; 16[7].} 37. {Cf. 9[18]; 13[1]_389;
 16[7].} 38. {Cf. 9[18]; 13[1]_389; 16[7].}
 39. We should only steal. . . taking notice.] {Cf. 17[59].}
 40. {Cf. [17[67]; 20[9].} 41. {Cf. 17[58].} 42. {Cf. 13[11];
 16[7]; 17[58].}

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43. {Cf. 17[58].}
 44. {Cf. 17[20, 25]; 18[34]; 22[5]_571; 22[5]_574.}
 46. {Cf. 17[55].}
 47. {Cf. 17[54].}
 48. is just to] soll nur... sein
 49. {Cf. 17[51]}
 so. {Cf. 17[51].}
 st. {Cf. 17[49].}
 52. {Cf. 17[48].}
 53. {Cf. 12[43]; 13[1]_397; 16[7]; 17[48]; 23[5].}
 54. divine lightness-skill] göttliche Leicht-Fertigkeit {N's
 word-
 play here is between Leichtfertig "taking things lightly"
 and
 Leicht-Fertigkeit "being adept at making ourselves light."}
 ss. {Cf. 17[66].}
 56. {Cf. 17[64].}
 58. {Cf. 17[70]; 22[1]_558.}
 59. {Cf. 17[70, 71].}
 60. are your own incidents and accidents!] was euch zufällt
 und
 auf euch fällt! {Cf. 17[68].}
 61. {Cf. 17[67].}
 62. {Cf. 17[67].}
 63. {Cf. 18[46].}
 64. happiness] Glück {This could also be "good fortune."}
 66. {Cf. 17[3].}
 67. {Cf. 17[3].}
 69. Oh these narrow . . . tenth generation] Oh diese en-
 gen . . . ins

zehnte Geschlecht {Cf. 17[7].}
 70. {Cf. 17[10], 26}; 22[1]_560.
 71. {Cf. 17[9]; 22[2].}
 72. {Cf. 17[29].}
 73. {Cf. 16[84]; 17[29]; 18[4]; 20[1]; 22[1]_548.
 74. in my little finger] in der linksten Zehe {We switch
 from
 "toe" to "finger" to render the idiom; cf. 17[30].}
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 75-
 {Cf. 17[28, 31].}
 our] seinen {We are translating this as a singular universal
 ("man"), but N might intend it as referring to Z himself or
 some
 individual in the narrative; cf. 17[32].}
 77: 78. 79.
 {Cf. 17[34].} {Cf. 17[34].} {Cf. 17[35].}
 . {Cf. 17[38].} . {Cf. 17[40].} . {Cf. 17[41].} . {Cf
 17[45].} . {Cf. 17[46].}
 {Cf. 17[60]; 20[9].}
 . {Cf. 17[50, 52, 60]; 18[1]; 20[9].}
 . {Cf. 17[63].}
 . {Cf. 17[63].}
 . {Cf. 17[65].}
 . {Cf. 11[r].}
 . {Cf. 17[70]; 22[1]_544.
 . Corpse robbers . . . fingers."} {Cf. 17[72].}
 . {CE 17174}
 ACE 17[74].}
 . {Cf. 17[76].}
 . {Cf. 17[78].}
 . {Cf. 17[78] . {See 17[80], note 157.}
 . It wants to command... . hard-heartedness.] {Cf. 17[80].}
 . {Cf. 17[82].}
 . {Cf. 17[85].}
 . {Cf. 17[85].}
 . "The worst... virtues] {Cf. 17[85].}
 . {Cf. 17[10].}
 . {Cf. 17[69].}
 . {Cf. 17[12].}
 . {Cf. 17[12].}
 . {Cf. rf}
 . {Cf. 17[26]; 22[1]_556.
 ; 18[15, 23]; 23[3].}
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 uo. {Cf. 17[10].}

un. "Let us be modest... snore.] {Cf. 17[10].}
 112. {Cf. 17[8].}
 13. {Cf. 3[1] 5.}
 114. Shortly before the final composition of Z III. {This
 section
 includes what appear to be possible titles for Z, but the
 paren-
 thetical comments and the outlines convinced us not to cap-
 ital-
 ize these items as we have done for the items in 22[8] be-
 low.}
 us. fatum] "fate"
 117. {Cf. 1[63]; 3[1] 12.}
 118. {Cf. 3[1] 22.}
 119. {Cf. 3[1] 24.}
 120. {Cf. 3[1] 23.}
 121. {Cf. 3[1] 38; 12[1] 118.}
 122. {Cf. 1[8, 9]; 3[1] 34; 311] 224.}
 124. {Cf. 3[1] 42.}
 125. {Cf. 4[114]; si] 176; 51]; 16[9].}
 126. ape] Affen {Cf. Z III "On Passing By," where N uses the
 same play on words between "ape" and "imitator."}
 127. {Cf. 3[1] 62.}
 128. {Cf. 3[1] 63.}
 129. {Cf. 3[1] 57.}
 Bo. {Cf. 1[70]; 3[1] a BGE 133.}
 131. {Cf. 2[45];
 132. {Cf. 2[so]
 133. {Cf. 1[70]; soh BGE 129.}
 134. {Cf. 2[47]; 301] {64}, p. 61, 3-8; 311] 72.}
 135. {Cf. 3[1] 71}
 136. {Cf. 311] 70}
 137. {Cf. staa] 311] 65; 4[44].}
 138. {Cf. 311] 74.}
 139. {Cf. 3[1] 82.}
 140. {Cf. 3[1] 105.}
 142. {Cf. 17[15]; 22[3]_569.}
 712
 143.
 144 145. 146
 147. 148.
 149 150. 151.
 {Cf. 16[84]; 17[29].}
 {Cf. 17[43]: 20[12].}
 Crumpled houses . . . bilious soul] {Cf. 17[13].}
 Where have I witnessed . . . as we wish.] {Cf. 17[13].}

firm] hart
 {Cf. 20[19].}
 Contented sows . . . to the wind.] {Cf. 17[13].}
 {Cf 30] 444.
 {Cf. 30] 429.
 bite of conscience] Gewissensbiss {We speak of "pangs of
 conscience," whereas the Germans speak of "bites of con-
 science."
 We preserve N's wordplay here; cf. 3[1] 436.
 153. {Cf. 3[1] 422; 12[1] 88.
 154. {Cf. 17[16].}
 155. This is the black sad sea . . . each night] {Cf. 17[14,
 15];
 22[3]_565.
 156.
 not give a plug nickel] keinen Heller geben {A "Heller" was
 a small copper coin worth about half a penny.
 157. 158. 159.
 160.
 161. 162. 163.
 164.
 165.
 166.
 167. 168. 169.
 170.
 Ifyou can't pray, .. . intellect] {Cf. 18[1].}
 lifts... from our shoulders] enthebt {Cf. 17[21].}
 {Cf. 17[21].}
 {Cf. 17[23].}
 Bible-thumpers] Betbruderei {Cf. 17[20]; 18[46].} Like
 22[2].
 {Cf. 18[2].}
 Like 22[1].
 {Cf. 17[22]; 18[18].}
 {Cf. 17[20, 25, 56]; 18[34]; 22[1]_552.
 {Cf. 17[16, 17]; 18[2].}
 {Cf. 17[17].}
 {Cf. 17[17].}
 is] ist {N uses the third-person singular ist to match
 "char-
 acteristic" with "means and condition."
 171. 172. 173. 174. 175.
 {Cf. 20[12].}
 a contrarian, .. . cheerfulness.] {Cf. 17[16].}
 {Cf. 17[16].}
 ill people . . . fall.) {Cf. 17[16].}

{Cf. 17[20].}

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176. {Cf. 17[16].}

177. {Cf. 17[6].}

178. {Cf. 20112.}

179. with a voice... at us.] {Cf. 17[16].}

180. {Cf. 17[24]; 18[46].}

181. [went in search... the future.] {Cf. 17[24].}

182. {Cf. 17[20, 25, 56]; 18[34]; 22[1]_5523 22[5]_571.}

183. {Cf. 17[25].}

184. {Cf. 17[25].}

185. {Cf. 17[13].}

186. {Cf. 7[43].}

(23 = Z 11 4)

2. {Cf. Matthew 3:17; Luke 3:22, 9:35.}

3. if we take a shit] wenn man Koth läßt {N's wordplay is between Koth (shit or filth) /assen – "to take a shit" – and, in the next sentence, Koth halten – "to keep it."}

5. {Cf. 18[z, 23]; 23[3].}

7. {Cf. 18[57].}

8. Compilation for a chapter from Z III that was never completed.

9. {Cf. 301] 243; 12[1] 101; 13[16]; 16[7].}

10. {Cf. 12[43]; 13[1] 397; 1617); 17148]; 22[1]_553-}

15. {This annotation is N's.}

[24 = Mp XVII 1b.]

17, 5196, 98]. 2. alienation] Befremden

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3. yvoun] "sign" "mark" "mind" "intelligence" "opinion" {The Greek is obscure here, and it is quite possible that there was an error when N's manuscript was transcribed.}

4. la Faustin] {Parisian actress and eponymous protagonist of Edmond de Goncourt's 1882 novel.}

5. {WP 1057.}

6. Cf. CW 15, 25[1, 6, 227, 323]; 26[259, 465]; 27[58, 80, 82]; CW 16, 34[191].

7. original chaos . . . perishing.] {WP 508.}

9. in regard to... its opposite.] {Cf. WP 92.}

10. Bourget p. 25.] A reference to Paul Bourget, *Essais de psychologie contemporaine* ("Essays on contemporary psychology") (Paris{: Lemerre,} 1883); cf. WA 7 note 66.

u. both of the greatest . . . this thought.] {WP 1058.}

12. origin] Herkunft {In CW, Ursprung is usually translated as "origin" and Herkunft as "descent," but we believe that the context dictates this rendering. Cf. note 34 below}

13. Psychology of Error] Title added later (August 1888) according to the plan in CW 18, 18[17].

15. {Cf. Richard Avenarius, Philosophie als Denken der Welt gemäss dem Princip des kleinsten Kraftmasses: Prolegomena zu einer Kritik der reinen Erfahrung ("Philosophy as thinking of the world in accordance with the principle of the least amount of energy: Prolegomena to a critique of pure experience") (Leipzig: Fues's Verlag (R. Reisland), 1876), 45-46.}

16. {Cf. *ibid.*, 46}

17. sensation] Empfindung {In this fragment, and in 24[13], we have departed from our usual translation of Empfindung as "perception" or "feeling" so as to reflect the fact that N is quoting from the positivist philosopher Avenarius.}

18. {Cf. *ibid.*, 47}

19. {Cf. *ibid.*, 47-48.}

20. {Cf. *ibid.*, 49.}

21. {Cf. *ibid.*, 50.}

22. "Tt is also the case that... such hastiness!] {WP 626.}

NOTES TO PAGES 588-598 715

23. the willing] das Wollen {In German, this could be either "wanting" or "willing," and here N is referring to the nature of the will and free will.}

24.

25. {WP 562.}

"In the development . . . at all!] {Cf. Avenarius, Philosophie als Denken der Welt, 58-59.}

26.

27.

28. 29. 30.
 31. 32. 33. 34. 35. 36. 37. 38. 39.
 40.
 41.
 42. 43. 44.
 what exists] Das Seiende
 form of existence] Form des Seins
 In motion... . existence.] {Cf. *ibid.*, 60.}
 A multiplicity . . . or separation.] {WP 641.}
 Science does not ask . . . hypothesis.] {WP 6673
 But willing: =... a goal.] {Cf. WP 260.}
 {Cf. WP 676.}
 Origin] Herkunft
 personal transformations] sich-Verändern
 {Cf. 7[47, 58, 62, 125]; 8[26]; 24[27].}
 {Cf. 3[1] 245; 4[165]; 11[8]; 18[43, 49, 56]; 21[6].}
 {WP 640.}
 measured by human senses] auf den Sinnenmenschen
 {WP 594.}
 emotions] Gemüth {See the Translators' Afterword, 738-44.}
 {WP 277}
 knowable] erkennbar
 {Cf. WP 670}
 general feelings] Gemeingefühle {Grimm defines this term
 as meaning sense impressions that have to do with the body
 in
 general, such as pain and hunger}
 46. 47- 48. 49. 50.
 51.
 52.
 53-
 54.
 {Cf. WP 670.}
 {WP 741}
 {WP 611.}
 {Cf. WP 130.}
 bétise] "stupidity" {Underlined by N.}
 suffrage universel] "universal suffrage"
 {Cf. Bourget, *Essais de psychologie contemporaine*, 152-53.}
 {Cf. WP 29.}
 At our core] im Innersten {"in our heart of hearts," "at the
 core of our being"}.
 716 NOTES TO PAGES 598-602
 55. "le fait"] "the fact"
 56. art... ourselves.] {Cf. Bourget, *Essais de psychologie
 contem-*

pordaine, 158-59, 209.}

58. {Cf. 7[47, 58, 62, 125]; 8[26]; 24[16].}

59. My Innovations. . . . universally shared existence.]

{Cf. WP

417.}

61. against... imperfection!] {Cf. WP 417}

62. {Cf. Francis Galton, *Inquiries into Human Faculty and Its*

Development (London: Macmillan, 1883), 213: "There is an Orien-

tal phrase, as I have been told, that the fear of the inevitable ap-

proach of death is a European malady."}

63. {Cf. WP 255.}

66. {Cf. WP 767}

67. {Cf. WP 671.}

Weltanschauung ("Force: A real-monistic worldview")

(Leipzigf:

Haupt und Tischler,} 1878). NZ.

69. matter] Stoff {We also render *Materie* as "matter" in the concluding sentence of 24[34].}

70. {Cf. CW 6: 19[3].}

71. *Omnia naturalia* . . . mala] "All natural things are indif-

ferent to the person who is acting; (it is) to the person who is

holding back, or denying, that they are good or evil."

Translators' Afterword

Paul S. Loeb and David F. Tinsley

The fragments and notes contained in this volume, which

Nietzsche wrote while composing *Thus Spoke Zarathustra* (Z), cover the period from July 1882 through the winter of

1883-84.

We begin by providing a biographical sketch for this time in Nietzsche's life. We then discuss briefly the philosophical works

he produced, as well as the principal authors and thinkers

Nietzsche was reading. The bulk of this Afterword is devoted to

issues of translation. We start by explaining our philosophy and

then illustrate our approach by providing examples of global translation decisions that could not be addressed in the end-

notes. We then focus our attention on the proper translation of Nietzsche's crucial terms *Mensch* and *Übermensch*, in light

of
Nietzsche's evolving philosophical concept of superhumans.
Nietzsche's Life, 1882-1884: A Biographical Sketch!
Other than occasional visits to his mother and sister in
Naumburg in Thuringia, Nietzsche's pattern of residence had
taken
on a certain regularity. Supported by his pension from the
1. For this section, we draw upon the Chronicle of Nietzsche
Life by Colli
and Montinari (KSA 15 / CW 19); Ronald Hayman, Nietzsche: A
Critical Life
(Harmondsworth, UK: Penguin Books, 1982); Curtis Cate,
Friedrich Nietzsche
(New York: Overlook Press, 2002); and Julian Young,
Friedrich Nietzsche: A
Philosophical Biography (Cambridge: Cambridge University
Press, 2010).
Thanks to Daniel Blue for helpful feedback regarding this
section.

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University of Basel, as well as by his mother's generous
ship-
ments of clothing and his favorite foods, he would spend the
summers in his "cave," a dark room in the second story of
the
Durisch family home in the mountain village Sils Maria in
southeastern Switzerland, and his winters in search of
healthy
air in a series of Mediterranean port towns, first in Genoa,
then in Rapallo, and finally in Nice.
1882 marked a time of turmoil and transition in Nietzsche's
life. Never robust, his health had worsened significantly
during
the previous year. His growing blindness had reached a crit-
ical
stage, and he struggled, with limited success, to control,
by
means of diet, exercise, and self-diagnosis, his frequent
bouts of
debilitating nausea and seizures. *Persona non grata* in
Bayreuth
after his break with Wagner in 1877, Nietzsche also experi-
enced
two significant periods of estrangement from his own family.
The first rift with his sister Elisabeth and his mother came

as a
 result of his catastrophic relationship with Lou Salomé,
 which
 reached its greatest intensity in Tautenberg in the summer
 of
 1882 and imploded in Leipzig in November of the same year.
 His friendship with Paul Rée was a further casualty of this
 failed relationship. A second major rift with his family
 followed
 Elisabeth's announcement, in September 1883, that she
 planned
 to marry the Prussian super-patriot and anti-Semite Bernhard
 Förster. Nietzsche found support and understanding in visits
 and correspondence with Franz and Ida Overbeck in Basel, as
 well as in his friendship with the composer Heinrich Kösel-
 itz,
 a.k.a. Peter Gast, who also served as Nietzsche's proofread-
 er
 and sometime scribe.
 In 1882 Nietzsche felt a semblance of good health restored,
 a
 return of energy and optimism, which brought renewed pro-
 ductivity in his philosophical writing. The winter and
 spring
 of 1882 had seen him complete *The Joyful Science*, in which
 he
 proclaimed the death of God. During his summer sojourn in
 Tautenberg, the only summer during these years he did not
 spend in Sils Maria, he was correcting the final proofs of /
 S.
 Having conceived the doctrine of eternal recurrence the
 previ-
 TRANSLATOR'S AFTERWORD 719
 ous summer at "The Rock" near Sils Maria, he finished part I
 of *Z* during a ten-day stretch of good weather in Rapallo in
 January 1883, part II in Sils Maria the following July, and
 part
 III in Nice in January 1884. According to his own account,
 he
 had taken up work on part IV, finishing it in February 1885.
 Although he would not begin the actual writing of *Beyond
 Good and Evil* until June 1885 in Sils Maria, Notebooks 4, 7,
 and 24 document how much the topics of that later book
 already occupied him during his writing of *Z*.
 Notebook 1 is dedicated to Lou Salomé, who visited Nietz-
 sche in Tautenberg, a scenic forested region south of Naum-

burg, beginning on 7 August, for three weeks of daily walks and intense conversations. Its tone reflects Nietzsche's exhilaration in anticipation of her visit. He had made her acquaintance through his friend Paul Rée, the German moral philosopher and Darwinist, whose *Psychologische Beobachtungen* (Psychological Observations) had inspired Nietzsche and broadened his exposure to British and French thinking. Salomé eventually proposed that the three of them live together, chastely, for a year in an informal "monastery of free spirits." This idealized community of minds provided a facade for the ruthless competition between the two men for an exclusive and less than chaste relationship with Salomé. Both of them unsuccessfully proposed marriage. Notebooks 2 and 3 stem from the last few days in Tautenberg with Salomé and from Nietzsche's time in Leipzig, where Rée and Salomé visited him after he had fled his family's enmity. His sister Elisabeth, who had turned against Salomé since their visit in Bayreuth, did all she could to turn Nietzsche's mother and Nietzsche himself against Salomé.' Notebooks 4-6 reflect a period of extreme isolation and depression in the winter of 1882-83, when Nietzsche considered

2. *Psychologische Beobachtungen* (Berlin: Duncker, 1875); translated and edited by Robin Small as *Psychological Observations*, in Paul Rée, *Basic Writings* (Urbana: University of Illinois Press, 2003), 1-80. Nietzsche's *Wayward Disciple* (Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press, 1968).

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suicide following the implosion of his relationship with Salomé. Nietzsche recovered enough to finish part I of Z. 4 Notebooks 7 and 9 stem from the late spring and early summer that Nietzsche spent in Genoa and Rome, a time of reconciliation with his family. Notebook 8 and Notebooks 10-14 were composed in the productive summer of 1883 in Sils Maria, where Nietzsche completed part II of Z. They coincide with his fi-

nal

break with Rée and his coming to terms with the end of his relationship with Salomé.

Notebooks 1s–21 contain notes from the late summer of 1883 in Sils Maria and the early fall, when Nietzsche was intensely occupied with part III of *Z*. Nietzsche also visited his

family in Naumburg for a few weeks until the second rift with

his sister. Notebooks 22 and 23 reflect Nietzsche's productivity

following the move to his new winter home in Nice; Notebook 24 stems from early January and February of 1884, when he completed part III of *Z* and resumed his work on part IV. Nietzsche's Notes on Secondary Sources?

The years 1881–83 marked a time of transition in Nietzsche's studies as well, from his self-described "middle" period to his

"late" period, and featured a review and rereading of authors

he had first consulted in the mid-1870s, including Schopenhauer, Emerson, Eugen Dühring, Philipp Mainländer, and F. A. Lange.[®] His creative focus for most of this period was on *Z*,

CW, on the different stages in Nietzsche's composition of *Z*. 5. In this section we offer a brief look at the principal sources that Nietzsche

cites, quotes, or paraphrases in the notebooks of this volume. A more

complete list of references to his source material may be found in the end-

notes. See Thomas H. Brobjer, Nietzsche's Philosophical Context: An Intellectual

Biography (Urbana: University of Illinois Press, 2008), 222–26, for a

comprehensive list of sources, organized by year and by notebook. For more

detailed analysis of Nietzsche's sources, organized by topic, see Robin

Small, Nietzsche in Context (Aldershot, UK: Ashgate, 2001). TRANSLATOR'S AFTERWORD 721

but there are also many preparatory notes that find later application in BGE. Notebook 7 even features an early version of

BGE 260, in which the notions of master- and slave-morality are presented for the first time.

The notes that Nietzsche took while developing his thoughts on the status of the self, the genealogy of morality, and the relationship of rational thought to the physiological functions of drives are found mainly in Notebooks 7, 15, and 16. In Notebook 7, where Nietzsche is writing on egoism and morality, we find notes on the German philosopher Eduard von Hartmann, whose *Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins* ("Phenomenology of moral consciousness")⁷ was an important source on Spinoza. Nietzsche's critique of metaphysics and of the "I" as a foundation of epistemology had many sources. Later in these notes he refers specifically to the German philosopher Gustav Teichmüller's *Die wirkliche und die scheinbare Welt* ("The real and the apparent world"),⁸ the dualism of Teichmüller's title being one of the fundamental concepts that Nietzsche wished to refute. Although Nietzsche's friendship with Rée ended with the Salomé debacle, his reception and rejection of Rée's ideas on moral philosophy continue in these notebooks (see Notebook 7n). Nietzsche reread Dühring's *Kursus der Philosophie* ("The course of philosophy")⁹ during this period. It is from Dühring that Nietzsche appropriated and modified the term *ressentiment* that would occupy such a key place in *On the Genealogy of Morality*! Many of Dühring's works are among the most heavily annotated in Nietzsche's personal library.

7. Eduard von Hartmann, *Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins: Prolegomena zu jeder künftigen Ethik* ("Phenomenology of moral consciousness: Prolegomena to every future ethics") (Berlin: C. Duncker's Verlag, 1879).

8. Gustav Teichmüller, *Die wirkliche und die scheinbare Welt: Neue Grundlegung der Metaphysik* ("The real and the apparent world: New groundwork of

metaphysics") (Breslau: Koebner, 1882).

Weltanschauung und Lebensgestaltung ("A course in philosophy as strictly scientific worldview and guide to life") (Leipzig: Koschny, 1875).

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The physiological bases of sense impressions and the dynamic of competing drives were another point of focus and study for

Nietzsche during this period. There is frequent reference to the

German zoologist and founder of experimental embryology, Wilhelm Roux. For the images of the body as source of expansion of energy and joy, Nietzsche draws upon the works of Mainländer (né Philipp Batz), the German poet and philosopher, particularly Mainländer's *Die Philosophie der Erlösung* ("The philosophy of redemption").¹ One source on feelings of

pleasure and pain that Nietzsche consulted at this time was the

French philosopher and psychologist Leon Dumont's *Vergnügen und Schmerz: Zur Lehre von den Gefühlen* ("Pleasure and pain: On the doctrine of feelings").² For the physiological mechanisms

informing sense impressions, Nietzsche appears to have relied upon Michael Foster's *A Textbook of Physiology*, in the Nicolaus Kleinenberg German translation,³ which drew substantially upon the work of Leipzig professor Ernst Heinrich Weber, who explored the connections between human physiology and psychology. Nietzsche also references three sources on

animal physiology and drives that he consulted during this time,

by the German ethnologist and animal ecologist Karl Semper, the French philosopher Alfred Espinas, and the German zoologist Georg Heinrich Schneider.

Nietzsche's eclectic interests in aesthetics, cultural history,

and law find mention elsewhere in these notebooks. He cites from the Irish historian William Lecky on architecture as well

as from the German classical art historian and archaeologist Johann Winckelmann's famous essay on depictions of suffering. Nietzsche's continuing fascination with the ancient Greeks

u. Philipp Mainländer, *Die Philosophie der Erlösung* (Ber-

lin{: Grieben,}

1876),

12. Léon Dumont, Vergnügen und Schmerz: Zur Lehre von den Gefühlen

(Leipzig: Brockhaus, 1876).

Kleinenberg (Heidelberg: Winter, 1881).

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is especially evident in Notebooks 8 and 24, reflecting in part

his reading of German classicist Leopold Schmidt's *Die Ethik der alten Griechen* ("The ethics of the ancient Greeks").!4

Nietz-

sche's interest in Eastern philosophy and Hinduism from his early period, which came from Schopenhauer, was revitalized in part by his rereading the translations and works of his friend

Paul Deussen, the German Indologist and professor of philoso-

phy at the University of Kiel. His references to guilt and inno-

cence in light of judicial punishment quote the German legal scholar Rudolf von Ihering.

Our Philosophy of Translation

Our goal in translating Nietzsche's unpublished notebooks is not only to provide a precise English translation of each word

or phrase but also to capture the style and spirit of what Nietz-

sche was trying to say, as Nietzsche might have formulated it

in English." For Nietzsche, language is everything. How clev-

erly Nietzsche expressed a thought was often as important to him as what he was saying. Thus, in searching for English equivalents for Nietzsche's German, we have sought to recapture at least some of the wordplay, wit, and clever phrasing (*Schlagfertigkeit*) that permeate his writing.

Communicating the sense of Nietzsche's text to readers who do not read German poses challenges rarely encountered when translating the philosophical writing of other authors. Some of

Nietzsche's formulations in these notebooks draw as much upon literary traditions, for example, the rhetoric of the apho-

rism – looking back to Goethe, Lichtenberg, Montaigne, and

14. Leopold Schmidt, *Die Ethik der alten Griechen*, vol. 1

(Berlin: Wilhelm Hertz [Bessersche Buchhandlung], 1882). Michael A. Scarpitti in their translation of the material known as *The Will to Power*. See their “Note on the Text and Translation” in *The Will to Power* (London: Penguin Books, 2017), xxvii-xxxiii.

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beyond – as they do upon the rhetoric of traditional philosophical argument. Many formulations anticipate the incredible range of rhetoric and genre that characterizes *Z*. As Clancy Martin rightly observes, [another problem with translating *Z* – perhaps the thorniest of all – is that Nietzsche imitates so many different kinds of writing in the book. As a philologist and nineteenth-century German, he is often classical: sometimes Thucydidean, sometimes Platonic, sometimes satirical after Juvenal or Persius, sometimes as clear, precise and methodical as Aristotle. As a minister's son and a parodist and opponent of Christianity his style is often biblical, and specifically Lutheran. And, finally, as German's greatest stylist yet, he is innovative and above all modern: modern in the sense that we more commonly associate with French and English writers in the early twentieth century.!]®

Our approach to translating Nietzsche set in motion a continuous process of linguistic exploration and return, analogous to that of expatriates, who, having been immersed in another language and culture, are confronted, after returning home, with the challenge of communicating the otherness of the experience in a language with a different vocabulary and different cultural norms and expectations. The Latin-derived English term “translate” and its inseparably-prefixed German equivalents *übersetzen*/*übertragen* connote this sense of carrying something over or across a barrier or divider – in this case, to use one

of Nietzsche's favorite metaphors, the vast ocean that divides

Nietzsche's nineteenth-century German and our twenty-first-century American English.

Navigating this "ocean" required continuous attention to the historical context of Nietzsche's language, which meant taking into

16. Clancy Martin, review of *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*, comparing the

translations of Adrian Del Caro and Graham Parkes, *Notre Dame Philo-*

sophical Reviews: An Electronic Journal, 2008.02.06, <http://ndpr.nd.edu/news/thus-spoke-zarathustra/>.

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account semantic developments in German – and in English – since Nietzsche's time. We therefore found it essential to consult

works such as Flügel's *Praktisches Englisch-Deutsches und Deutsch-*

Englisches Worterbuch in zwei Theilen ("Practical dictionary of

the English and German languages in two volumes") from 1852, Grieb's *Deutsch-Englisches und Englisch-Deutsches Wörterbuch* ("Dictionary of the English and German languages") from 1885,

Kiirschner's *Universal-Konversations-Lexikon* ("Universal encyclopedia for conversations") from 1900, and Biichmann's *Geflügelte*

Worte: Der Citatenschatz des deutschen Volkes ("Dictums: A treasury

of quotations for the German people") from 1882 and 1910, along

with the Nietzsche Wörterbuch from the De Gruyter Nietzsche Online

resource, the indispensable online Grimm Wörterbuch (Grimm), and

the condensed print and online editions of the OED." Although

we did not view reference works contemporary with Nietzsche as

definitive in themselves, they did help us decide, for example,

whether *vergewaltigen* ("to rape" in modern German) was to be understood predominantly in sexual terms, how positively

the image of a Biedermann ("man of honor" or "upright citizen") was viewed in Wilhelminian society, and how Übermensch and übermenschlich were translated before Nietzsche. The descriptions and illustrations in Kürschner helped us to reimagine the science, technology, and fashion of the nineteenth century. Biichmann allowed us to identify the sources and specific phrasing of famous quotations and literary allusions, as they were understood in Nietzsche's time. In the endnotes, we provide translations of quotations in French, Latin, and Greek; we document Nietzsche's frequent references and allusions to events and proverbs of the Luther Bible; Wörterbuch in zwei Theilen (Leipzig: Julius E. Richter; Hamburg: Meissner, 1852); Christoph Fr. Grieb, Deutsch-Englisches und Englisch-Deutsches Wörterbuch, 2 vols. (Stuttgart: Neff, 1885); Joseph Kürschner, Universal-Konversations-Lexikon (Berlin: Hermann Hilger Verlag, 1900?); and Georg Büchmann, Geflügelte Worte: Der Citatenschatz des deutschen Volkes (Berlin: F. Weidling, 1882, 1910).

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we identify philosophers and authors prominent in Nietzsche's time, some of whom remain largely unknown to nonspecialists; and we define obscure technical terms from proto-industrial Wilhelminian society such as Nachen ([jolly] boat) or Fliegenwedel (shoe-Ay/fly whisk).

Notes on Some Common Grammatical Constructions

Because of their origins as West Germanic dialects of Indo-European, as well as the structural and pedagogical influence

of Latin on the development of the written languages, German and English have many grammatical constructions in common. However, divergent patterns of usage mean that some constructions flow more naturally in one language than in the other, even when both languages accept them as gram-

matical. That's why we sometimes choose alternatives that we think read better in American English, in order to capture the

fluency and impact of Nietzsche's German."?

A salient illustration of this approach involves how we render

the third-person singular universal pronoun *man*. Following Walter Kaufmann, a few translators still render *man* by using the universal impersonal third-person English pronoun "one." Although grammatical, the usage of "one" as an impersonal universal is disappearing from American English, replaced by pronominal universals such as "you" or "we." The challenge is

that Nietzsche uses *man* continually in his writing, and such usage flows naturally in Nietzsche's prose. But when one uses

"one" to render *man*, one often finds that one's prose no longer

flows quite so well. That's why we chose to substitute the pro-

nominal plural universal "we" for *man*, along with its posses-

sive pronoun "our" for *sein*.

18. Hill and Scarpitti follow a similar approach: "[T]here are many

grammatical constructions which, while equally possible in both languages,

are far more natural in German than in English." Thus, they prefer not to

"reproduce such constructions at the price of making Nietzsche's writing

appear far clunkier in the original that it actually is" (Will to Power, xxix).

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Man liebt immer nur seine We always love only our desire
Begierde und nicht das Begehrte. and not what we desire.

(3[1] 105)

This use of first-person plural can introduce a nuance of inclu-

sion between narrator and readers that is not conveyed by *man*.

We adjust our phrasing wherever this nuance conflicts with what we think Nietzsche was trying to say. The pronoun *man* can also function as a passive substitute in German, something

that has no real equivalent in English. When Nietzsche uses

man in this way, we render it in the passive whenever possible.

Personen, die man zu einem People who were employed for an Unternehmen benutzt hat, enterprise which has failed should welches mifSrathen ist, soll man be doubly compensated.

(1[5])

doppelt belohnen.

Inflection

The fact that German is more highly inflected than English influenced our basic approach in decisive ways.

(1) We add the noun "people" to adjectival constructions in which the nominal form is omitted in order to distinguish between das Gute (the good, what is good) and die Guten (good people). We realize that in doing so we are moving away

from usage that has been accepted since Kaufmann. But translating both das Gute and die Guten as "the good" introduces ambiguity that is not there in the German, where inflection

makes it clear whether the reference is to a quality or to a

person. Thus, when we translate die Guten as "good people," the chapter title Von den Tugendhaften in Z as "On Virtuous People," and so on, we are not adding anything to what Nietzsche

says. His formulations make it clear which one he means;

we are merely preserving the clarity of the original.

(2) Differing levels of inflection also mean that word order is

used more often to convey emphasis in German, whereas English

typically uses word order to identify subject and object functions

and must therefore rely upon adverbial phrases or clauses to convey

emphasis. Nietzsche often begins declarative clauses with the

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accusative object or a prepositional phrase, a standard syntactical

device to convey emphasis in German. Retaining such inversion

in the English sentence results in clunky phrasing or even ambiguity.

We therefore prefer to use standard English word or-

der

and try to convey Nietzsche's emphasis in other ways.

Über jedes Leiden sind wir We are outraged by each act of
empört, wenn es sinnlos ist, suffering, when it is sense-
less,

"unverdient" ... "undeserved"... (7[9])

(3) In German, inflection allows readers to identify most
pro-
nominal antecedents through gender, number, and case agree-
ment; in English, readers must rely on number agreement and
syntax. In cases where the antecedent of "it" is not clear
in

English, we replace "it" with the nominal form of the
anteced-

ent to preserve the clarity of Nietzsche's prose, as with
our

substitution of "the ocean" (in bold) in the following pas-
sage

Ich blicke hinab in das Meer: I look down into the ocean: it
lies

still steht es und tiickisch blickt _ placidly and out of it
an image

mir aus ihm ein Bild entgegen. looks treacherously back at
me.

Ein kostbares Bild mit weißen In its arms the ocean holds
Brüsten hält es in seinen Armen: a priceless image with
white

träge und tückisch schleicht es breasts: it steals languidly
and

über den Sand, daß – – – treacherously across the sand, so
that – – – (9[t])

Flavoring Particles (Modalpartikeln)

German and English both use adverbial flavoring particles to
convey nuances of the speaker's intentions or expectations.

But

different flavoring particles have emerged in the historical
devel-

opment of each language, and even where cognates have sur-
vived

(denn!"then"; nämlich!"namely,"), it is not always prefer-
able to

use the cognate or even one equivalent word to express what
Nietzsche was trying to convey. The semantic diversity of
the

flavoring particle doch and the temporal connotations of the
fla-

voring particle erst pose particular challenges, and we provide the

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following examples to illustrate our approach. The ubiquitous

doch occurs almost four thousand times in Nietzsche's writings

and functions not only to convey greater emphasis but also as the

principal particle of contradiction for negations and of contrast

for diminutions. The context determines that we render doch as

"still" (7[25]), as "but" (7[30]), as "yet" (7[44] and 7[52]), and as

"and yet" to begin a clause (7[75]).

The particle erst has two principal contexts in Nietzsche's notes:

(1) As a synonym for zuerst ("first" or "initially"), for example,

marking the first time an action or event occurs.

(2) In combination with adverbs or conjunctions, jetzt erst, dann erst, erst wenn, or by itself, as a synonym for erst recht, for

example, when the action or event is occurring for the first time but not until or only after an initial condition has been

met. The challenge is to find an equivalent in English that expresses this nuance of conditional temporality. We think that negating the resulting action or event, as in the following

example, conveys the conditional aspect and allows the English

to flow as naturally as Nietzsche's German.

Erst wenn ihr diirstet, sollt ihr You should not drink until you

trinken: und erst wenn der Geist are thirsty: and you should not

euch treibr, sollt ihr tanzen. dance until the spirit moves you.

Und lernt erst lügen, damit ihr And only learn how to lie so that

versteht, was Wahrheit-reden ist! you understand what truth-

Der Hunger erst soll euch zur telling is! You should not be

Wahrheit zuriicktreiben: und driven back to the truth until

wenn ihr voll seid der guten you are hungry for it: and when

Weine der Wahrheit, werdet ihr you have drunk your fill of the
 auch tanzen wollen. good wines of truth, then you
 will also want to dance. (23[6])
 To render Erst wenn ihr dürstet, sollt ihr trinken as “you
 should
 y
 drink only when you are thirsty” conveys the restrictive nu-
 ance
 y y y y:
 but misses the nuance of “not until” implicit in Nietzsche’s
 use
 of this construction.

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Gerundive and Standard Nouns of Creativity or Cognition
 Nietzsche makes extensive use of attributive and nominal
 gerundives to designate cognitive or creative activity. For exam-
 ple, he is careful to differentiate between the standard
 noun for
 “creator, der Schöpfer, and its gerundive variant, “someone
 who
 creates,” der Schaffende, with the latter term occurring in vari-
 ants over two hundred times in his works, notes, and let-
 ters. To
 render both Schöpfer and Schaffender as “creator” obliterate
 a
 key semantic distinction in Nietzsche’s German. Therefore,
 we
 maintain the distinction by using “one who creates” or
 “some-
 one who creates” in the singular and “those who create”
 when-
 ever we pluralize to preserve gender neutrality (see below).
 We
 follow the same approach with analogous pairs such as Ken-
 ner!
 Erkennende (connoisseur/someone who knows), Lehrer/Lehrende
 (teacher/someone who teaches), and so on.

Singular Universals

Nietzsche frequently uses masculine singular inflection in
 his
 discussions of species (der Mensch), ethnicity (der
 Chinese), or
 vocation (der Dichter). Take, for example, his claim “der

Mensch

wird durch seine Instinkte geleitet" (7[239]), which has tradition-

ally been translated as "man is guided by his instincts."

When

Nietzsche uses masculine singular inflection in such contexts,

he does not have an individual in mind, but rather a universal

prototype that embodies all of the qualities typically associated

with humanity. In choosing Mensch instead of Mann, Nietzsche clearly has a universal prototype in mind that includes men and

women. But as soon as a possessive pronoun is required, German

and traditional English usage both call for masculine inflection

(sein/"his").

We decided to move away from traditional English usage

for two reasons: (1) our desire to preserve gender neutrality –

we no longer wanted to allow masculine inflection to stand for the universal prototype; (2) we were concerned about the TRANSLATOR'S AFTERWORD 731

potential that contemporary readers less fluent in German might confuse the gendered connotations of "man" and "his" with the universal connotations of these pronouns. We then weighed some contemporary translators' alternatives for rendering such universality. We decided against universalizing the possessive pronoun itself by pluralizing it (der Dichter! sein

= "the poet"/"their") for two reasons: (1) it is ungrammatical;

(2) there is the potential for overlap with pronouns associated

with emerging gender-neutral usage in the US. We also decided

against using feminine inflection ihr/"her" consistently or alternating the gender of the possessive pronoun (sein = "his,"

then "her," then "his," etc.). Any of these approaches would obscure or even destroy the complexly consistent gendering that is one of the foundations of Nietzsche's worldview. In the

end, we settled upon the option of pluralizing nominal forms

as a grammatical alternative that preserves the sense of proto-typical universality. Thus, we render "der Mensch wird durch seine Instinkte geleitet" as "human beings are driven by their instincts."

We extend this pluralization model to include ethnic designations:

Der Chinese ißt sehr viel The Chinese eat very many
Gerichte in sehr kleinen dishes in very small portions.
Portionen. (81)

as well as to vocations,

Wer als Dichter mit baarem Those who, as poets, want to pay
Golde zahlen will, muß mit with pure gold must pay with
seinen Erlebnissen zahlen: their experiences: for this reason,

deshalb verbittet sich aber der though, poets refuse to tolerate

Dichter seine nächsten Freunde having their closest friends as

als Interpreten – sie errathen, interpreters – their closest
indem sie zurück rathen. friends figure things out by
giving them feedback. (7[111])

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as well as to masculine singular interrogative universals:
Wer seinen Gegner tödten will, Those who want to kill their
mag erwägen, ob er ihn nicht enemies should consider whether
gerade dadurch bei sich this act will immortalize their
verewigt. enemies for them. (12[1] 77)

and even to some neuter singular gender designations:

Vom Weibe On Women {not: "On the
Woman"} {title of 1[111]}

As soon as a singular modifier is added, either an adjective (der

christliche Gott! "the Christian God") or a restrictive phrase or

clause (die Unschuld der Lügen "the innocence of a lie"), the singular definite article is called for in English. In the plural,

the definite article is often dropped: die weiblichen Affecte =

"female affects." In general, when a masculine possessive universal is called for, we pluralize.

Punctuation

Translators of Nietzsche still struggle with the issue of

rendering

his punctuation. We have tried to preserve Nietzsche's original

punctuation wherever possible. This works well, for the most part, with colons, semicolons, dashes, and exclamation points.

However, the rules dictating comma usage differ to such a degree

between German and English, especially in regard to dependent clauses, that we do occasionally delete Nietzsche's commas

where English usage does not call for them. We also add commas where their absence would result in ambiguity or lack of clarity in rendering Nietzsche's original.

Translating Unpublished Fragments

Translating Nietzsche's unpublished fragments meant taking several issues into account that surface less often when translating

his published works.

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Issues of Genre

Nietzsche used these notebooks for many different purposes.

He composed Z between 1883 and 1885, and large portions of the notebooks served as a laboratory for working on outlines and phrasing for Z. Our readers can follow his different plans

for organizing the material, changes in the titles of the different

sections, and early versions of passages that are among his most

famous. There is even a brief outline for a Z drama. There is also

a good deal of material relating to the composition of BGE, notably in Notebooks 3, 7, 12, and 15; BGE appeared in 1886. The notebooks in this volume also contain a small collection of

poems, Nietzsche's notes on authors and works he was reading,

and commentary on philosophical topics and issues of the day.

Issues of Style

A significant challenge involved translating the frequent ellipses.

Often Nietzsche chose not to complete a thought, substituting three long dashes, which could indicate that he

con-
sidered the conclusion to be foregone or else that he be-
lieved
he still had work to do.
Eure Krankheiten treten gegen Your ailments set themselves
euch auf und verklagen euch ob against you and accuse you on
der Tugenden, deren ihr euch account of the virtues you
gloat
briistet: und was euch nicht about: and what doesn't suit
auf den Leib paßt, wie sollte your body, how should this
das ein — — — — — (17[13])
Nietzsche also frequently abbreviated words for which Colli
and Montinari supplied emendations. Here, on occasion, we
adjusted the angle-bracketing of the words to make the Eng-
lish
as comprehensible as the German:
So w(enig) Viernunft) a(ls) As little) r(eason) a(s) p(oss-
ible)
m(öglich) — das ist, artiger — this is, more delicately
geredet: Zufall. Auf den Füßen phrased: chance. All things
run
des Zufalls laufen alle Dinge there and back on the feet of
hinweg und zurück — — — chance — — — (18[30])
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As a general rule, we tried to convey rather than to resolve
ambiguities in Nietzsche's original phrasing. We preserved
the
ellipses, kept fragments fragmentary, found English equiva-
lents for his abbreviations, and retained ungrammatical us-
age.
We only provided emendations when it seemed to us that the
text of our translation would appear incomprehensible to the
English reader in a way that Nietzsche's original text would
not appear to the German reader.
We also learned to be alert to Nietzsche's use of apposit-
ives,
generally a series of two or more unpunctuated, equivalent
nouns or phrases. Rendering these appositives differs from
rendering a grammatical series, that is, three or more nouns
or
phrases joined by commas and a concluding conjunction (usu-
ally und/"and" or oder/"or") that signals whether they are
to
be considered as alternatives or as synonyms within a col-
lec-
tive concept. Unless the lack of punctuation renders the

frag-

ment incomprehensible, we provide an English equivalent for each appositive without punctuation in order to maintain the ambiguity of relationship conveyed by Nietzsche's German. Zarathustra 3. einsam gottlos Zarathustra 3. alone godless furchtbar fürchterlich soll terrible terrifying, Zarathustra Zarathustra dem Einsiedler should appear this way to the erscheinen – hermit – (17[75])

Our readers will also notice that Nietzsche repeats or revises

particular thoughts, turns of phrase, or even entire fragments

within the body of our twenty-four notebooks, a process that will extend into volume 15 of The Complete Works and, in some

cases, into Z (CW 7) itself. Some changes involve as little as

substituting a semicolon for a comma. In other places, Nietzsche-

sche undertakes minor revisions; see, for example, the four variations at 13[1]_ 379, 13[12], 16[7], and 22[1]_550. Colli

and Montinari

note many of these variants, but they also miss a substantial

number of them. We provide what we hope are comprehensive lists of these passages, with the goal of allowing readers

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to follow how Nietzsche's phrasing and thoughts evolved during

the three-year period covered by this volume.'

Issues of Content

Our approach to translating the content of the fragments and notes collected in this volume has been influenced by the existing translations of Z and of other works that Nietzsche would subsequently publish, especially BGE. The history of translating Z into English extends back more than a century, generating not only a working English vocabulary for Z but also a range of possibilities for the translation of each fragment-

ment. We sometimes break with precedent, most notably in our translation of Mensch and Übermensch, but also in translating some other key terms (see below). Once we determine the translation of an individual term in a particular context,

we use that translation in all of Nietzsche's notes to Z and in our translation of Z.

We do not document which specific fragments Nietzsche chose or adapted for Z, beyond those already noted by Colli and Montinari. In our view, making such connections is in itself an interpretive act. The De Gruyter Nietzsche Online website provides the most complete documentation of Z references in the unpublished material. Any repetition of a term or

even a particular phrase can easily be documented by an on-line search. We document repetitions or adaptations of individual fragments within the notes themselves. For the longer fragments, such as 13[1], 13[3], and 22[1], we provide the page

number within this volume as a convenience to our readers.

Our volumes also contain material that Nietzsche chose not to use for Z, for example, in Notebooks 13 and 15. This presents

a different challenge for translators. Although we have the

published version of Z to document Nietzsche's final decisions

19. Locating such parallel passages is done most efficiently through on-

line searches on websites such as NietzscheSource and De Gruyter's Nietzsche Online.

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regarding diction and phrasing, there is no way of knowing what decision he had made at the time he recorded a particular note or a particular version of a fragment. The absence of a

term, such as Pergament, or a character, such as Pana (13[3]_

401), or a scene, such as Zarathustra's conversation with the

king in 13[4], in the published version of Z, or conversely, its

presence in abandoned material, is not necessarily evidence against its validity as part of the process of development in

Nietzsche's phrasing and thought. Therefore, even if all translators

agree on the rendering of a term or phrase in the published

lished version of Z, this does not guarantee that such a rendering is valid for Nietzsche's notes.

There are also extended sections that contain the actual notes that Nietzsche took on works by authors such as Emerson, von Hartmann, and Roux, most notably in Notebooks 7, 15, 16 and 24. Where Nietzsche quotes from German translations of works written originally in English or French, our editors, Alan D. Schrift and Duncan Large, assisted us in finding existing English versions of those works. Where Nietzsche

appears to be paraphrasing or rendering the content in his own words, we provide our own translation.

Other sections, most notably "Böse Weisheit"/"Wicked Wisdom," the collection of aphorisms at the beginning of Notebook 12, consist of excerpts or revisions from earlier works such as *The Birth of Tragedy*, *Dawn*, and *Human, All Too Human*, plus material that would be included in BGE. In such cases, passages are noted and the sources are identified

wherever possible. Some notebooks contain material subsequently incorporated into the text edited by Nietzsche's sister

and published as *The Will to Power*. If the work Nietzsche is quoting has already appeared in the Stanford edition of Nietzsche-

sche's Complete Works, we use the existing Stanford translation of the passage, although we do standardize the rendering

of grammatical constructions like man (see above) as a courtesy to our readers.

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Translating Nietzsche's Poetry

The period from 1882 to 1885 also marks Nietzsche's return to

poetry after a five-year hiatus." Indeed, in the eleven-year pe-

riod between the publication of "An die Melancholie" ("To Melancholy") in 1871 and the poems of */S*, Nietzsche published

only three poems, "Der Wanderer" ("The Wanderer"), "Am Gletscher" ("At the Glacier"), and "Der Herbst" ("Autumn"). Nevertheless, as Philip Grundlehner has noted, Nietzsche "believed poetry to be a vital and inseparable part of his pro-

duction as philosopher." The "New Columbus" variants

included in this volume illustrate the fact that Nietzsche "revised many of his poems sometimes over a period of years,"

which is further evidence that he took his poetry seriously."

And unlike Schopenhauer, Nietzsche's "poetry is not separate from philosophy" but rather "it adds a dimension that prose does not permit."?*

We attempt to convey the beauty and profundity of Nietzsche's poetry, but we do not attempt to duplicate his rhyme schemes, thereby privileging accuracy in content over the aesthetic effects of form.

In regard to word order, German inflection

allows for even greater latitude in poetry than it does in

prose. This is also true of English, to a more limited degree.

Hence, we do maintain German word order in some lines whenever we think that doing so preserves the integrity or the

flow of a particular poem.

20. In translating the poems that appear in these notes, we drew upon

several insights presented by Philip Grundlehner, *The Poetry of Friedrich*

Nietzsche (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1986).

21. "The Wanderer" was included in a letter to Erwin Rohde (18 July

1876, KGB II:5, 177): "At the Glacier" and "Autumn" were both composed

during Nietzsche's ill-fated but productive stay in Rosenlaubad above Bern

in August 1877. For the original text and an English translation, along with

extensive analysis, see Grundlehner, *The Poetry of Friedrich Nietzsche*, 63-88.

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A Glossary of Standardized Terms

In the glossary that follows, we discuss our choices for some

important terms in Z and the notebooks that are associated with it, especially in cases where we diverge from precedent.

In our endnotes, we briefly state our reasons for rendering other less common or more obscure terms.

aufheben – The word fields divide in English among (1) the standard meaning of the verb aufheben, which we render as “abolish”; (2) specialized meanings in conjunction with particular accusative objects (we “lift” a ban, we “set aside” a judgment, we “repeal” a law); (3) the reflexive verb sich aufheben, which we render as “cancel themselves out” or “nullify themselves”; (4) and variants of the reflexive noun Selbst-Aufhebung, which we don’t think Nietzsche intended in a Hegelian sense and which we render as “self-abolishing,” to mirror the form of Nietzsche’s key term Selbstüberwindung (“self-overcoming”).

Bildner (der) – Here we follow Gary Handwerk in HAH and HAH II, rendering Bildner as “sculptor” (Handwerk also uses “shaper”), except for the hyphenated noun Götzen-Bildner, where we follow the standard English locution “idol-makers.” Nietzsche generally prefers Künstler for “artist” (almost a thousand occurrences in his works, notes, and letters) and reserves Bildner as a special metaphor of creation through destruction.

Empfindung (die) – At B in the Critique of Pure Reason, Kant translates Empfindung with the Latin *sensatio* and Wahrnehmung with the Latin *perceptio*. Following this suggestion, English-speaking translators of Kantian and post-Kantian German philosophical texts have usually chosen to render these two terms as “sensation” and “perception.” But Kant is idiosyncratic in this respect and is not following any generally accepted usage in the German language. In fact, as these notes show, Nietzsche uses the term Empfindung in a much wider sense that actually does follow the generally accepted use of this term and

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does not adhere to the very technical and restricted use proposed by Kant for use in philosophy discussions related to his

preferred topics. It is true that post-Kantian philosophers such as Hegel and Schopenhauer attempt to follow Kant's usage in this respect (hence the similar translation of their use of these two terms), but it is certainly not the case that all German philosophers continued to follow Kant's proposed meanings. Nietzsche did not; in fact, as our translation shows, he most often had in mind the affective sense of the term *Empfindung* that is best captured by our English term "feeling." Moreover, when Nietzsche does have in mind the more cognitive associations of the term *Empfindung* (as in 7[198] and 24[13, 15, 16]), he usually has a wider sense in mind that is best captured by our English term "perception." When Nietzsche clearly has something like sensation in mind (as in 7[139] and 7[223]), we have not hesitated to render *Empfindung* as "sensation." In short, we should not always apply Kant's severely restricted and technical distinction between *Empfindung* and *Wahrnehmung* to Nietzsche's use of these terms unless we are positive that Nietzsche is quoting or discussing some Kantian or neo-Kantian text or topic (as in 5[1]239 and 7[223]). Our translation looks closely at each place where Nietzsche uses these two terms and makes a case-by-case contextual decision that we think best captures his meaning.

erkennen/Erkenntnis (die) /Erkennende(r) – In contrast to the fundamental verbs of knowing, *wissen* and *kennen*, which describe a situation, condition, or result, *erkennen* and its variants describe a process through which knowledge is gained. Of the semantic variants for *erkennen* cited in the *Deutsches Wörterbuch* von Jacob und Wilhelm Grimm, we distinguish in Nietzsche's notes between the mundane sense of "to recognize" or "to realize" and the epistemological process paraphrased in Grimm as *geistiges erkennen und einsehen*, which can include knowledge or insights gained through reason or experience.

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Rather than attempt to generate an artificial vocabulary that could do justice not only to distinctions within standard

German usage but also to philosophical discourse then and now, we decided to render Erkenntnis/Erkennen as “knowledge/known.” We opted for this conventional rendering for three reasons: (1) it reflects actual English usage in the epis-

temological debates among Kant’s British interlocutors such as Locke, Berkeley, and Hume, of which Nietzsche was aware and which he took into account; (2) it has been preserved and sustained in contemporary philosophical discourse about Nietzsche’s epistemology; (3) it better reflects Nietzsche’s semantic

preferences in the unpublished notes, where erkennen predominates over wissen. We document a few exceptions in the endnotes.

Erlösung/erlösen – We translate Erlösung as “redemption” in most passages, rendering Nietzsche’s litany Erlösung von Erlösern

as “redemption from redeemers.” We believe that “liberation” is

closest to N’s meaning in 16[z] and 16[33], and we use this to

render his other litany, Man soll das Weib im Weibe erlösen as

“Woman must be liberated from women.” In some contexts, we prefer the biblical phrasing “to deliver ourselves” or “to deliver

us from” because of the potential confusion with the therapeutic

connotations of “redeeming ourselves.”

Feuerhund (der)/Höllenhund (der) – Feuerhund and Höllen-

hund designate the same being in Nietzsche’s notebooks, where images of hell predominate (cf. 13[2], 13[3]_400 and 13[3]_403), as well as in Z II and IV, where there is more em-

phasis on classical mythology and on Zarathustra’s quest for essential minerals from the center of the earth. Translators from Kaufmann onward have chosen the literal rendering “firehound/fire-hound/fire hound” for Feuerhund, which we did not adopt for three reasons: (1) “firehound” is a neologism

that has no place in the English vocabulary of the underworld

or hell; (2) in English, compound nouns beginning with

“fire”

usually connote beings, tools, or structures that prevent fire,

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not embody it; (3) “firehound” does not resonate with the po-

litical connotations that most commentators see in Nietzsche's

Feuerhund. The word Feuerhund can also mean “andiron,” but this sense of the word has a separate etymology.” The American

English equivalent of Feuerhund is not “firehound” but rather

the regional southern variant “firedog,” further evidence that

Hund should not be translated here by its cognate. Höllenhund

is the German equivalent of the English word “hellhound,” used in folklore studies to designate any mythical dog with supernatural powers. As a category, hellhounds include Cerberus,

the three-headed monster dog that guards the gates of the

Underworld in Greek mythology; Garmr, the bloodstained guardian of Hel's gate in Old Norse mythology; and the raven-

ing wolf/dogs that accompany Wotan or Graf Hachenberg in the Germanic mythology of “The Wild Hunt” (Die wilde Jagd), popularized by Jacob Grimm and adapted by several composers in Nietzsche's time. We render Höllenhund as “hound of hell” and Feuerhund as “hound of fire” to preserve the semantic distinction while retaining the parallels in form.

Freigeist [der] /Freigeisterei [die] – After consultation

with our editors and with translators across CW, we have translated

this term as “free spirit(s)” when the context indicates Nietzsche's positive position vis-a-vis what he is saying about these

figures, as in 1[42] and 20[3]. We have translated the term as

“free thinker(s)” when the context indicates that Nietzsche is

voicing criticism vis-a-vis these figures, as in 4[16],

6[1], and

6[4]. We provide an endnote whenever the context calls for a departure from this general principle.

Frau [die] /Weib [das]/Weibchen [das] – Weib was the prevalent gender designation in Nietzsche's time, referring to women of every age, social status, and class. As the generic

25. See Grimm. Similar citations will subsequently be referred to according to the URL provided by Grimm for the term, in this case, <http://www.woerterbuchnetz.de/DWB?bookref=3,1594,56>. Both of our nineteenth-

century German-English dictionaries translate it as “and-iron” or “firedog.”

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term, its connotations were neutral, and designations could venerate or disparage, depending on its modifiers.° Readers accustomed to *Fraulein* as the primary designation for gender and social function in modern standard German must come to terms with the different semantic emphasis of Nietzsche's time, as illustrated by Nietzsche's comment in an early

letter to Erwin Rohde (9 December 1868; KGB I:2, 351):

“Ubr-

gens auch mit seiner Frau, die ein ganz unmenschlich verdienst-

volles Weib sein soll” (By the way, the same thing is true of his

wife, who they say is an admirable woman in every way).

The translator's dilemma lies in finding equivalents for the above reversal of nuance, since the singular noun “woman?” is

not only the generic term in English for an adult female, paired with “man,” but also can designate, in the singular without an article, the entire gender. We believe “women” is the best term for universal gender designations (see above), since the plural can stand for Nietzsche's pronouncements about the entire gender. In the case of Nietzsche's mantra “Das Weib im Weibe erlösen!” (To redeem the woman in women!; 16[50]), we use both the singular and the plural to preserve the distinction Nietzsche has in mind.

We searched long and hard for an English term that could convey the misogynist etymology associated with Weib, the literary motif of misogynist disparagement, *das böse Weib*, and

the expletive *Weiber!* in German. Contemporary slang

("bitch," "witch," "wench," etc.) is too transitory and fails to resonate with the entire English-speaking community. American women colleagues whom we consulted suggested the technical generic term "female" in its colloquial form as the best misogynist equivalent, so we have made use of that.

26. <http://www.woerterbuchnetz.de/DWB?bookref=28,329,25>: "an sich gilt weib für die frau jedes alters und standes, für die ledige, verheirathete, verwitwete, lebende und tote, für jungfrauen und mütter" (weib is a valid designation for a woman of any age and social class, for unmarried, married, widowed, living and dead women, for virgins and mothers).

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Nietzsche's love of supercilious diminutives such as ein altes Weibchen or ein junges Weibchen further complicates the process. "Little old lady" is a fair rendering of the former term, but there is no good equivalent in English for "little young lady." The Z I chapter title "Von alten und jungen Weiblein" presents a particularly interesting challenge. We follow Kaufmann, Del Caro, and Parkes with some minor variations in rendering it as "On Little Women, Old and Young."

Geist (der) – Most scholars agree that this term is one of the most difficult to translate, because there is no single word in English that captures everything that is meant by the German word. Accordingly, we have chosen to translate this word in different ways depending on the context. Where we think that Nietzsche is emphasizing the cognitive, rational, and intellectual aspects of the term, we have rendered it as "mind" or "intellect." Where we think that he is emphasizing the term's affective nuances having to do with emotion, feeling, pleasure, and value, we have rendered it as "spirit." This is not to say, however, that either of these aspects is meant to exclude the

other. For example, a freier Geist is a "free spirit" in the sense

of being an independent and morally unconstrained person who is liberated on both cognitive and noncognitive levels." Gemiith (das) – Our translation of Gemiith reflects its tran-

sitional status in Nietzsche's time.® In early translations from

the Latin, Gemiith could be equated with either mens (the mind) or animus (the spirit). In the eighteenth century, Gemüth designated the home of all mental faculties, including

perception and concepts or thoughts, "the total unity of our inner being," of which Geist (mind) was just a part. In the late

eighteenth and early nineteenth centuries, Gemüth became more narrowly associated with Empfindungen (feelings/sense 27. Thanks to Matthew Meyer for his advice on this entry.

28. http://www.woerterbuchnetz.de/DWB?bookref=5,32_93,72.744

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impressions/sensations) and came to be understood as the repository for emotions and even sensuality. By the middle of the

nineteenth century, the tendency was to distinguish between Geist, the mind as repository of reason and understanding, and

Gemiith, the faculty of feeling and perception.

Gleichniss/Gleichniß (das) – Nietzsche makes frequent ironic reference in these notebooks to the concluding rhymes of Goethe's Faust II, "Alles Vergangliche ist nur ein Gleichnis" (All

that is transitory is only a symbol). In passages where the allusion

to Faust is clear, we render Gleichnis as "symbol," following al-

most all Faust translators. In biblical contexts, we render it as

"parable." Elsewhere the context dictates whether we translate it

as "metaphor," "simile," or "analogy."

hart/Härte (die) – Although most translators have chosen to render these terms with the English cognate in all contexts, we

see a clear distinction in American English usage between "hard" as an attributive for objects versus "hard" as an attributive-

tive for persons. Flügel, one of our nineteenth-century sources, preserves the distinction between “rough, harsh, severe” conditions and “callous, fierce, inhuman” attitudes. The same problem exists for “hardness.” We don’t say “he showed great hardness in his dealings with others.” We don’t believe Nietzsche is restricting hart to a physical characteristic. He means “hardened,” “callous,” or “unyielding.” Our solution is to render hart, when meant as a personal attribute, as “hard-hearted.” We add attributes to the nominal variants that specifically signal that Nietzsche has personal characteristics in mind, such as “hardness of feeling” or “hardness of heart.” For example, we render the key phrase from Z III, “The Wanderer,” Gelobt sei, was hart macht, as “Praise be to whatever makes us hard-hearted.” For descriptive predicate adjectives, we prefer “hardened.”

héhere Menschen – With the exception of Graham Parkes, all Z translators use the English cognate “higher” in this context. We do not follow precedent here, because we do not believe

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that “higher men” or “higher human beings” conveys what Nietzsche is trying to say. The standard English equivalent adjective expressing connotations of “greater” or “more significant” is the Latin term “superior,” not “higher,” and that is what we use, except when English usage of the nominal form dictates something else, such as “more lofty feelings,” “greater pleasure,” or “higher purposes.”

kleine Menschen – Here we choose alternatives to the English phrasing “small people” or “little people,” in which there is too

much potential for ambiguity between connotations of stature and connotations of social significance. We settled upon “puny”

as the adjective that best conveys Nietzsche’s contempt. We settled upon “smallness” as the best equivalent of the nominal

form, Kleinheit.

klug/Klugheit (die) – In Nietzsche it is necessary to distinguish

between cleverness and prudence. For example, we render ihre dreiäugige Klugheit as “her three-eyed cleverness” (3[1]

181), but die Moral der Klugheit as “the morality of prudence”

(7[38]) and the chapter title in Z II, “Von der Menschenklugheit,” as “On Human Prudence.”

Kraft (die) – In most cases Nietzsche uses Kraft in scientific

contexts to mean something like “force.” There are a few passages

in Nietzsche’s notes where Kraft is better rendered as “power.” We note these exceptions.

Nächste (der)/Nachstenliebe (die) – The challenge here is to render the biblical phrasing that Nietzsche has in mind, translated in the most current version of the New Revised Standard Version of the Bible as “neighbor,” while avoiding confusion with the American English designation “neighbor” as “someone living close by.” Nietzsche himself plays with these connotations in 3[1] 202: “Unser Nächster ist nicht unser

Nachbar’: so denken alle Politiker und Völker.” We render it as “Our neighbor doesn’t live in the neighborhood’: this is how all politicians and peoples think.” We choose to render

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the nominal form Nächstenliebe in biblical terms as “loving thy neighbor,” as in Jesus’s second great commandment, “Love thy neighbor as thyself.”

Selbstsucht (die)/Herrschaft (die) – Nietzsche uses the term Selbstsucht in contrast to several antonyms, in order to

refute the negative connotations traditionally associated with this

term. We render Selbstsucht as “selfishness” throughout our volumes,

in contrast to Herrschaft (“imperiousness”), Nächsten-

sucht ("neighborliness"), Gemeinsucht ("public-spiritedness"), and Selbstlosigkeit ("selflessness").

sollen/wollen – Nietzsche uses the dichotomy between the modal verbs du sollst and ich will repeatedly in these notebooks. This is his shorthand for the kind of human transformation he desires, moving from obedience before an external omnipotent God (du sollst) toward the internal imperative of the individual's will to power (ich will). To highlight the bibli-

cal context, we render the phrase du sollst, the basis for the Ten

Commandments in German, in the archaic language of the King James Bible: "thou shalt."?? Translators since Thomas Common have rendered ich willin Nietzsche as "I will," which is problematical for several reasons. (1) /ch will without an

infinitive verb is transitive and connotes either desire or present-

tense volition, rendered most accurately as "I want (to)."

The

English equivalent "I will" is also transitive but connotes either future intention or present willing, not the modality of

wanting. (2) If Nietzsche intended to render both as modal verbs, omitting the infinitive because it is irrelevant, then "I

want to" and not "I will" is the proper rendering. (3) In plac-

ing the spirit of the lion above the gold-scaled dragon in "On

the Three Transformations," Nietzsche is reversing the ideal modeled by Jesus in the Garden of Gethsemane. In the King James version of Luke's gospel this passage reads: "Saying, 29. The New Revised Standard translation of the Bible renders this as

"you shall."

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Father, if thou be willing, remove this cup from me: nevertheless-

less, not my will, but thine, be done." Luther rendered this as

"und sprach: Vater, willst du, so nehme diesen Kelch von mir,

doch nicht mein, sondern dein Wille geschehe!" By contrast, Nietzsche advocates a transformation whereby humans will act according to the imperative "My will be done," that is,

"What-

ever I want to happen, shall happen!" The English phrase "I will" with no accusative object does not convey this; most read-

ers would understand this phrase as meaning "I will do this."

Thus, to communicate the essential nuance of volition, we translate ich willas "I will this."

Tafel (die) – For the nominal root, we distinguish between biblical contexts, in which we render Tafel as "tablet," and the

contemporary context of moral philosophy, in which we render the term as "code." This differentiation allows us to pre-

serve the traditional rendering of the Z III chapter as "On Old

and New Tablets."

Zufall (der) – We translate the phenomenon as "chance" and an individual instance as a "coincidence" or an "accident."

We now move from a general discussion of our translation choices to a specific discussion of how we translate Nietzsche's

crucial terms Mensch and Übermensch.

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Translating Mensch and Übermensch

From Man to Humans

In German, the etymology of equivalents for "man" diverges into a masculine singular term for the male gender, der Mann,

and a masculine singular term for the human species, der Mensch? Der Mensch has its origins in the adjectival form of Mann, but even the earliest sources show der Mensch and a neuter variant das Mensch?! signifying "in general, a human being, of both genders and of any age . . . and this general meaning occurs frequently in the singular as well as in the plural."?? The degree to which this contrast between the mas-

culine singular form and the universal connotations became entrenched is evident in the surviving sixteenth-century sin-

gular idiom, das alle Menschen, as in "so wird dein alle men-

schen lachen" (then what is completely human in you [literally, what you share with all humans] will laugh). The flexibility of Mensch in connoting universality extends to an

interchangeability of definite and indefinite articles (der Mensch can have the same connotation as ein Mensch). Species designations can occur in both the singular and the plural, thus making the pluralization of Mensch less significant than

is usually the case.

Grimm documents the three principal occurrences of the masculine singular noun Mensch: (1) the metaphysical distinction

between God the Creator and his human creations – “der Mensch, der Schöpfung Ruhm und Preis” (Gellert; human beings, the crown and prize of creation); (2) the mythological

distinction between gods and humans – “je mehr du fühlst ein Mensch zu sein, desto ähnlicher bist du den Göttern”

30. There is a parallel etymology for the universal usage of the singular

noun Mann in German, but Mensch dominates the word fields surrounding

this usage.

31. The modern German slang variant das Mensch, i.e., a “woman of easy

virtue,” is a later development.

32. <http://www.woerterbuchnetz.de/DWB?bookref=12,2021,16>.

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(Goethe; the more you feel yourself to be human, the more you resemble the gods); and (3) the hierarchical distinction between angels, humans, and animals – “Was ist der Mensch? Halb Tier, halb Engel” (Haller; What are human beings? Half animal, half angel).” As we might expect, the metaphysical dimension evoked by Haller in the third example is absent in these two volumes of notes and in Z. Humans are most often designated by the masculine singular noun Mensch with the masculine definite article der. In contrast, the representative

animal that Nietzsche most often chooses is the ape, designated by the singular noun Affe with the masculine definite article der.

Up until twenty years ago, given our philosophy of translation, the English equivalent designation “man” with the possessive pronoun “his” would have been our choice. But twenty-

first-century English usage requires that Mensch be rendered in

its nongendered form, as “human” or “human being.” The first possibility we considered was to maintain the singular

universal in English, in this case “the human being” or “the human.”

But as soon as Nietzsche uses a possessive, the required form in English is “his,” which violates the universal meaning of Mensch in German as well as our aim of gender neutrality. For reasons that we reviewed at the start of this Afterword, we rejected switching to a gender-neutral pronoun such as “its” in such cases, or to an ungrammatical plural possessive such as “their.” But when we pluralized the Mensch occurrences, we found that the English reads well and that Nietzsche’s intended meaning is preserved: “Human beings are something that must be overcome.”

Pluralizing der Mensch, as we pluralize der Chinese or der Dichter, not only preserves gender neutrality whenever singular possessive pronouns are used, it is also consistent with the meaning and etymology of Mensch, even as it preserves the universalizing effect of its idiomatic usage. In the history of

33. <http://www.woerterbuchnetz.de/DWB?bookref=12,2021,16.750> TRANSLATOR’S AFTERWORD

the German language, what is meant is not one individual but a universal prototype that stands for the entire human species, men, women, and children. Moreover, Nietzsche talks about human beings in two, largely distinct contexts. When Nietzsche’s context is the human species, we render Mensch as “humans” or “human beings,” depending on what reads better. When Nietzsche’s context is universal human behavior or psychology, we render Mensch as “person” or “people.” Notice that, in this latter context, the singular with a definite article, “the person” or even “a person,” does not convey the same degree of prototypical universality.

The Modifier übermenschlich

Most striking within the etymology of Übermensch and its

variants is the predominance of the adjectival and adverbial form *übermenschlich*, beginning in the sixteenth century, when

the German theologian Wendelin Steinbach defined it by reference to the Latin adjective *supernaturalis* in terms of qualities

that are beyond humanity, such as immortality.' A digital search of texts published before 1850 contained in Projekt Gutenberg yields scores of citations of the adjectival form or its

nominal derivations (*das Übermenschliche* "the superhuman" or "what is superhuman"; *etwas Übermenschliches* "something superhuman").*° By Nietzsche's time, *übermenschlich* had become

a standard term to describe powers or abilities that exceed human

capacity or capability, as in E. T. A. Hoffmann's *Die Elixiere des*

Teufels (The Devil's Elixir; 1815-16): ". . . ja ich fühlte in dem

Augenblick eine übermenschliche Kraft in mir emporkeimen . . . "

("indeed, in that moment I felt within myself a burgeoning superhuman strength"). Moreover, the standard English translation for the term *übermenschlich* was well established by the

34. <http://www.woerterbuchnetz.de/DWB?bookref=23,418,75>.

35. Nietzsche's earlier works demonstrate that he was accustomed to us-

ing the adjectival and adverbial forms. Cf. BT 1; Philosophy in the Tragic Age

of the Greeks 8; HL 6 (CW 2, 122, |. 24); SE 6 (CW 2, 229, |. 36); WB 11 (CW

2, 327, |. 27); HAH 111, 143, 164, 441, 461; WS 73, 190; D 27, 60, 113, 548.

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mid-nineteenth century: it was "superhuman." The 1852 edition

of Flügel (p. 966) and the 1885 edition of Christoph Grieb's *Deutsch-Englisches Wörterbuch* (p. 879) both translate *übermenschlich*

exclusively as "superhuman."® And there is almost universal agree-

ment among translators today that "superhuman" is the best ren-

dering of *übermenschlich*??

From Superman to Overman

The etymology of the noun *Übermensch* demonstrates how Nietzsche took a word that had been in common usage since the Reformation and reshaped it for his own purposes. First docu-

mented in Dominican correspondence from 1527, *Übermensch* was used to describe the followers of Luther." Although Nietzsche-

sche did not coin the term, *Übermensch* came to be associated with Nietzsche. In the 1882 edition of Biichman's *Geflügelte Worte*, the German equivalent of Bartlett's *Familiar Quotations*,

there is no mention of Nietzsche or *Übermensch*. Yet, according to

the 1910 edition, "The particular way that *Übermensch* is understood today was first developed through Nietzsche" (p. 424).

Before Nietzsche, the adjectival/adverbial form *übermenschlich*

was the much more common term. After Nietzsche, the nominal form *Übermensch* achieved greater notoriety and usage. Nietzsche

himself uses *übermenschlich* only a few times in this volume of

notes, out of a total of nearly fifty occurrences in his works,

notes, and letters. By contrast, *Übermensch* occurs almost two

hundred times in his oeuvre, with almost one third of these occurrences documented in this volume.

36. Bilingual dictionaries, by their very nature, tend to focus on well-

established terms and more conventional usage. Both dictionaries appeared

before Nietzsche's publications during the period of this volume and before

those publications were well or very widely known. Furthermore, of the four

German adjectival synonyms immediately cited in Grimm, the two containing

the prefix *über* are also translated in modern English through the Latin variant:

übernatürlich as "supernatural" and *überirdisch* as "supernatural" or "superlunary."

Handwerk, HAH §111 (CW).

38. <http://www.woerterbuchnetz.de/DW> B?bookref=23,417,31.

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The translation history of *Übermensch* as a Nietzschean concept is much more contentious than that of its adjectival and

adverbial variant, *übermenschlich*. For more than a half century,

the standard translation of *Übermensch* was the upper-case noun

"Superman." In 1903 George Bernard Shaw translated Nietzsche's term *Übermensch* in this way in his famous and influential play *Man and Superman*. "Superman" was also Thomas Common's choice in his 1909 revision of the first English translation of *Z* (in 1896) by Alexander Tille (who had chosen

"beyond-man"). Although Shaw and Common capitalized the term "Superman," this is not required by the German text any more than Nietzsche's parallel term *Mensch* calls for capitaliza-

tion of the English translation "human."

"Superman" remained the standard translation of *Übermensch* until Kaufmann coined the term "overman" in 1954 and convinced most scholars to follow his lead. Kaufmann offered his-

torical, morphological, and etymological arguments in favor of

"overman." We will summarize these arguments and then explain briefly why we chose not to accept them. Faced with the

monumental task of rehabilitating Nietzsche as a philosopher for American readers less than a decade after World War II, Kaufmann argued against the term "Superman" because he thought it brought to mind politically charged reminders of Nazi eugenics propaganda. But of course the term *Übermensch* brings to mind the same associations and reminders for speak-

ers of the German language. Other translators have expressed reservations about the potential for contamination by the name

"Superman" in popular literature, comics, and film. But in fact

Nietzsche's concept has had a significant influence on these popular references." In any case, the shift in translation prefer-

ence for *Mensch* from "man" to "human" (see above) puts these reservations to rest.

39. Cf. Adam Barkman, "Superman: From Anti-Christ to Christ-

Type,"

in *Superman and Philosophy: What Would the Man of Steel Do?*, ed. Mark D.

White (Malden, MA: Blackwell, 2013), 111-20.

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Kaufmann's morphological arguments focused upon the proper rendering of the prefix *über*. English offers two possibilities for the context in question, one derived from Latin,

"super,"

and the English cognate derived from West Germanic, "over."

Translators who have recently followed Kaufmann in rendering *Übermensch* with the term "overman" or the ungendered and capitalized term "Overhuman" cite Kaufmann's argument that this term best conveys Nietzsche's associations with other *über*

terminology that is usually rendered by means of "over," such as

Überfluss ("overflow"), *überwinden* ("overcome"), and *übergehen*

("to pass over").⁴ They also cite Kaufmann's reference to Nietzsche's

knowledge of Ralph Waldo Emerson's concept of the Over-Soul in his 1841 *Essays*. But we think that the Latinate prefix "super" carries with it many of the same connotations of

elevation and preserves enough of the wordplay with Nietzsche's

parallel "over" locutions and contrasting "under" locution. Also, we don't think there is any conceptual connection between Nietzsche's concept of the *Übermensch* and Emerson's idealistic concept of the Over-Soul. In any case, the fact that

Nietzsche did not coin *Übermensch* renders moot the argument that "over" is a more felicitous translation than "super" because

Nietzsche was familiar with Emerson's notion of the Over-Soul. Finally, as we mentioned above, the Latinate prefix "super" is quite naturally and standardly used to translate the

adjectival and adverbial form *übermenschlich*, and we think it

more important to capture this grammatical relation than the associations with other *über* terminology. Nietzsche uses the modifying form frequently in *Ecce Homo*, in association with the nominal form (EH "Destiny" 5).*

40. Friedrich Nietzsche, *Thus Spoke Zarathustra: A Book for All and None*, ed. Adrian Del Caro and Robert B. Pippin, trans. Adrian Del Caro (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2006); Friedrich Nietzsche, *Thus Spoke Zarathustra: A Book for Everyone and Nobody*, trans. Graham Parkes (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2005). *Studies* 30 (2005): 102-14, 103.

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In his etymological arguments for rendering *Übermensch* as "overman," Kaufmann claims he is going back to an "older term, 'overman, which has been reinstated.'"4? But by "older" he does not mean the English Nietzschean term used by previous translators such as George Bernard Shaw or Thomas Common (who both chose "Superman"); instead, he means an archaic English term that referred to a labor foreman, supervisor, or overseer. Obviously, this archaic term has nothing to

do with Nietzsche's term.* We think it is time to dispense with

Kaufmann's neologism. Whereas Nietzsche's term *Übermensch* has a history and a place in the German language prior to his

influential use of it, the term "overman" in a Nietzschean sense

has no history or place in the English language at all. From Overman to Superhumans

Our choice was therefore between "superhuman" and an ungendered modification of Kaufmann's neologism, "overhuman." We found "superhuman" to be the better choice because it corresponds to current standard English usage in its word field

and because it is part of a tradition of translating *Übermensch*

that extends back to the beginning of the sixteenth century. Moreover, in standard usage the universally accepted equivalent for *Untermensch* draws upon the Latin tradition: we say "subhuman." To maintain consistency, rendering *Übermensch* as "overhuman" would thus require a second neologism, "underhuman." In GM I 16, Nietzsche describes Napoleon as "diese Synthesis von Unmensch und Übermensch" (this synthesis of an inhuman and a superhuman). Here again, the standard term "superhuman" fits perfectly in this context,

without

42. Walter Kaufmann, Nietzsche: Philosopher, Psychologist, Antichrist, 4th

ed. (Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press, 1974), 115.

43. A further counterargument to Kaufmann's morphological and etymolog-

ical justifications for "overman" can be found in his translation of JS 382 in The

Gay Science (New York: Vintage Books, 1974). If his arguments are valid for the

noun, they should be equally valid for the adjective, yet Kaufmann renders

the hyphenated adjective menschlich-übermenschlichen as "human, superhuman."

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us resorting to the neologism "overhuman." "4 Certainly, the

original meaning of Kaufmann's archaic term does not lend

itself at all to the ungendered modification "overhuman,"

which has now become a completely invented English word.

And we find it telling that Kaufmann does not follow his own arguments but translates this passage as "this synthesis of

the

inhuman and superhuman."

Once we agreed on the term "superhuman" for Übermensch

in the Z volumes, we were confronted with the same challenges

discussed above concerning how to translate Mensch. To translate

late der Übermensch in the singular introduces the same ambiguity

between the adjectival, "the superhuman," referring to qualities or behavior, and the nominal, "the superhuman,"

referring

to beings. More important, when Nietzsche uses the term in its masculine singular form with the definite article, in most

cases he is using the term as a masculine singular universal. As

with the identical use of Mensch, Nietzsche does not have a single individual in mind but rather the universal prototype of

an entire species.

Ich liebe den, der lebt, damit I love those who live to know

erkenne und der erkennen will, and who want to know so that damit der Übermensch lebe. the superhumans may live. (5[17])

Here Nietzsche's singular demonstrative *den* does not stand for one individual but rather for any individual who lives to know, and Nietzsche asserts that the purpose of these individuals living to know is so that the superhumans may live. As with *Mensch*, we did not want to render universal possessive pronouns in the singular with the masculine pronoun "his." In pluralizing both the demonstrative and the noun in the 44. When we experimented with rendering the adjectival form, the prefix "over" seemed particularly out of place; "superhuman virtues," for example, simply sounds better than "overhuman virtues" (25[80]). There is also the potential for confusion with adjectives like "overeager" between "over" and "overly," where readers wonder whether Nietzsche means "over and above" or "excessively."

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above passage and elsewhere, we achieve Nietzsche's desired meaning, maintain gender neutrality, and avoid the misleading masculine singular inflection that has led some commentators to see *der Übermensch* as a single (male) individual. Many translators and scholars have concluded that *der Übermensch* refers to a special kind of male individual because Nietzsche uses the singular noun with a masculine definite article along with the associated masculine pronouns (*ihn* and *sein*) (see, e.g., 4[171], 4[224], *sl*₁, 12[17], 13[1], 18[56]). But Nietzsche makes identical and parallel uses of his term *der Mensch*—a term that translators and scholars routinely and correctly translate as a collective singular universal that means "humans" or "human beings." Moreover, Nietzsche will often move back and forth, with no contextual difference, between the singular noun, *Mensch*, and the equivalent plural noun, *Menschen*, and there are several passages in which he does the same thing with *Übermensch* and *Übermenschen* (see, e.g., 4[254], 5[32],

10[37],
10[41], and 13[26]). The fact that Nietzsche sometimes uses the plural nonuniversal inflection *Übermenschen* is not evidence that he is using the singular *Übermensch* to refer to an individual but rather further grammatical evidence that he is using the singular universal inflection to refer to a category, group, or prototype. There is no place in these notes, or in *Z*, where the context shows that Nietzsche is using *Übermensch* to refer to specific individuals. Nor is there any such place for Nietzsche's contrasting expressions, *der letzte Mensch* (the last human beings) and *der kleine Mensch* (puny human beings). These should be compared with Nietzsche's use of the term *der höhere Mensch* (superior human beings), especially in part IV of *Z*, where the context clearly shows his intent to refer to specific individuals (such as the sorcerer, or the ugliest man, or the one-eyed pope).

Finally, some have argued that it is best to leave the term *Übermensch* untranslated because it is well known by Nietzsche

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scholars and even to some extent in the culture at large." However, a general editorial decision was made that the entire

Complete Works would leave no German words untranslated.

Also it would be odd to leave just the single term *Übermensch*

untranslated in the whole *Z* book and in all the associated note-

book material. More to the point, it would also be excessive to leave all of the associated adjectival and adverbial locutions

(*übermenschlich*) untranslated; but if they are translated, the

reader will lose the connection to the untranslated *Übermensch*.

Our decision to translate the masculine singular universal

Übermensch as “superhumans” obviates the reasons usually given in favor of capitalizing or gendering the English translation of *Übermensch*. It also avoids a potential typographical confusion between the nominal and modifying forms of this term (“superhuman”), and it removes the misleading suggestion, implicit in the term “Superman” and the associated male pronouns, that Nietzsche’s term refers to a male individual. Beyond these etymological and morphological arguments, we believe that there are compelling exegetical and philosophical arguments, rooted in the Z notebook material and in Z itself, for understanding *Übermensch* in terms of a species and not an individual. We now turn to these arguments.

Nietzsche’s Philosophical Concept of Superhumans

Throughout his career, Nietzsche uses the philosophical concept of superhumans in three different ways. We will call these the supernatural use, the superior-individual use, and the superior-species use. He inherited the first two uses from earlier traditions in German writing, one having to do with philological investigations of validating mythological narratives, and the other having to do with the Romantic valorization of heroic None, trans. Clancy Martin (New York: Barnes and Noble Classics, 2005).

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individuals. But he invented the third use in response to Darwin’s theory of the origin of the human species. This particular use did not exist in the German language at all, not even in Nietzsche’s own published texts, prior to its introduction in 1883 with the publication of the first part of Z.%

The Supernatural Use

Nietzsche’s first published use of the concept of superhu-

mans

occurs in the first edition of /S, §143, titled "Greatest Advantage of Polytheism."

This is the key passage:

The invention of gods, heroes, and superhumans of all kinds, as well as near-humans and subhumans [Uebersmenschen aller Art, sowie von Neben- und Untermenschen], of dwarves, fairies, centaurs, satyrs, demons, and devils was invaluable training for justifying the selfishness and sovereignty of the individual:

the freedom granted to one god in relation to other gods was in turn granted to oneself in relation to laws and customs and neighbors.*7

Read contextually within the rest of §143, this passage relates the

concept of superhumans to the idea of polytheism. For this reason,

the concept might be called a theistic concept. But this passage

also relates the concept of superhumans to a group of invented

supernatural beings who, like the gods, live above and outside

human beings, in some distant superworld (über sich und ausser

sich, in einer fernen Ueberwelt). These beings are associated with

gods but are not themselves gods. They include heroes, near-humans, subhumans, dwarfs, fairies, centaurs, satyrs, demons,

and devils. This is why we have called this first published mention

a supernatural use of the concept of superhumans. Nietzsche also

But it applies as well to the more common adjectival and adverbial form,

übermenschlich – as, for example, Nietzsche's supernatural use of this form

in BT §1, his superior individual use of this form in D §548, and his superior

species use of this form in JS §382.

47. In this passage, Nietzsche uses the alternative spellings, Uebersmensch and Ueberwelt.

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contrasts his term Uebersmenschen with the linguistically related terms Nebenmenschen and Untermenschen, in this way positioning human beings at the center of a hierarchy of invented supernatural beings. The supernatural beings who are superior to human beings would seem to be the gods, heroes, and superhumans; those who are semi-equal to human beings would seem to be the dwarfs, fairies, centaurs, and satyrs; and those who are inferior would seem to be the demons and devils. The superhumans thus belong among the superior and elevated beings in Nietzsche's supernatural catalogue, along with the gods and the heroes. But even the heroes are not actually existing human beings, only invented mythological beings (like Odysseus or Siegfried). There is thus an important contrast to be drawn here with Nietzsche's second use of the concept of superhumans, a use that refers to actually existing figures such as Borgia and Napoleon. Nietzsche's supernatural use of the concept of superhumans is not original to him. He inherited this use from a tradition of philologists and historians who were seeking to discover the linguistic and mythological sources that could be used to define and validate what it meant to be German. These scholars applied the term when they were describing the hierarchies of invented gods and humans in their discussions of Greek, Roman, and Old Norse mythologies. Here is a representative example from Jacob Grimm's discussion of the sagas' representation of the "idisi" or wise women: Yet from the earliest times it [the term idisi], like the gr. vbuqn, appears to have been applied primarily to superhuman beings, who were seen to be lower than goddesses, higher than earthly women, taking the middle level that is under discussion

here."

48. Our decision to use "human" in place of the traditional English designation, "man," automatically shaped our choices for the variants of Mensch that Nietzsche uses in his works, notes, and letters: Gottmenschl "god-humans"; Halbmenschl "half humans"; Mitmensch! "fellow humans"; Nebemenschl "near-humans"; Uebermenschl "superhumans"; Unmenschl "inhumans"; and Untermenschl "subhumans."

49. Jacob Grimm, *Deutsche Mythologie*, 3rd ed., vol. 1 (Göttingen: Dieterichsche Buchhandlung, 1854), 372.

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It is noteworthy that in this first published mention of the concept of superhumans, Nietzsche uses the plural term Uebermensen instead of the collective singular term Uebermensch. This is because, as we argue below, Nietzsche's later

use of the concept no longer refers to a mere plurality of individuals (whether supernatural or actually existing) but

rather to

a single new species that could emerge sometime in the future

and would be superior to the human species.

In the unpublished preparatory notes collected in this volume,

Nietzsche never mentions this supernatural use of his concept

except in the very indirect and metaphorical sense that the members

of this new species will relate to human beings as if they were

indifferent Epicurean gods (7[21], 16[85]). However, in the published

Z he does allude back to his earlier supernatural use when

he has Zarathustra describe what poets have typically believed

about this concept. Here is the key passage:

Yet this is what all poets believe: that those who prick up their ears while lying in the grass or on secluded slopes experience some aspect of the things that are between heaven and earth.

And if tender stirrings come to them, then the poets
always think that nature herself is in love with them:
And she creeps up to their ears to tell them secrets and
enamored flatteries: the like of which makes them boastful
and bloated before all mortals!

Oh, there are so many things between heaven and earth of
which only poets have allowed themselves to dream!

And especially above heaven: for all gods are poetic
metaphor, poetic plunder!

Truly, we are lifted ever higher – namely to the kingdom
of the clouds: it is there that we place our motley young
fools

and then call them gods and superhumans [Götter und
Übermenschen]: –

Still, they weigh just enough for these thrones! – all these
gods and superhumans [alle diese Götter und Übermenschen].

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Oh, how weary I am of all these things that don't measure
up, that are supposed to be must-see events! Oh, how weary I
am of poets! (ZII "On Poets")

This passage is important because it includes the book's only
pejo-

rative and dismissive mention of the concept of superhumans.
For this reason, it is often cited as Nietzsche's critique
of his

own new Zarathustran concept of superhumans." However, a
closer reading shows that this particular mention overlaps
with Nietzsche's earlier use of the plural "Uebermenschen"
in

JS §143 in the following ways: superhumans are invented and
false; they are supernatural and associated with gods; and
they dwell above human beings in distant, cloudy heavens. By
contrast, Zarathustra teaches that his own goal of creating
superhumans can only be realized once all gods are dead;
that these superhumans will be the natural fruit of thou-
sands

of years of selective breeding among the descendants of his
disciples; and that these superhumans will inhabit the earth
and constitute the meaning of the earth. Thus, Nietzsche's
actual point in this passage is to highlight the uniqueness
and originality of his own Zarathustran use of the concept
of

superhumans. He does so by contrasting it with the supernat-
ural use of this concept by earlier scholars of mythology
such

as Jacob Grimm. Of special interest to Nietzsche is the in-

fluence of these scholars on the poetic compositions of Wagner in which he dreamed up colorful fantasies of airy, imperfect, and quasi-divine superhumans. It is true that Zarathustra begins his speech by including himself among the poets who lie too much. Yet at this point in the speech where he has reviewed the lies that poets tell about superhumans, he has also declared that he is weary of such lies and indeed that he is weary of all poets, old and new, because they are all superficial, muddled, and vain.

so. Cf. Tom Stern, "Nietzsche on Context and the Individual," *Nietzsche-forschung* 15 (2008): 299-315.

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The Superior-Individual Use

Following the publication of *Z*, Nietzsche uses the term *Übermensch*

only six times in the texts that he published or prepared for publication. For the reader's convenience, we have collected these passages in the Appendix below. He uses the term once in *On the Genealogy of Morality* (GM 1 16), once in *Twilight of the Idols* (TI

"Forays" 37), once in *The Anti-Christian* (AC 6), and three times in *EH* (*EH* "Books" 1, *Z*, "Destiny" 5).°! These published passages are noteworthy, especially when considered together, because they reflect Nietzsche's appropriation of an earlier Romantic use of the concept of superhumans that is distinct from the philological use outlined above as well as from his new and original Darwinist use in *Z*.

In these passages Nietzsche expresses his view that there exist certain individual human beings who possess such extraordinary abilities that they should be regarded as superior in

value

to most other human beings. One of the most famous and enduring presentations of this view can be found in Machiavelli's

Prince, where the virtu-laden Cesare Borgia is glorified as the

best example of such a superior individual. This is why Nietzsche

repeatedly mentions this lesser-known Renaissance figure in these passages. Following Machiavelli, Nietzsche is concerned

to pit his admiration of Borgia against the socially sanctioned

"idealistic" type of superior individuals, that is, individuals who

are usually regarded as superior in value to most others on account of their saintly and moral qualities. To Machiavelli's

Renaissance Borgia, Nietzsche adds Napoleon as his own age's very best instance of a superior individual. Moreover, as Machi-

avelli did with Borgia and as he himself does with Borgia (BGE

197), Nietzsche emphasizes Napoleon's terrible, monstrous, and

inhuman aspects as contributing to his superior value: "Napoleon:

one comprehends that the higher human being and the terrible

51. In EH, Nietzsche also quotes two places in Z where he uses the term

Übermensch (EH "Books" Z, "Destiny" 5).

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human being necessarily belong together" (CW 17, 10[5]).

More

abstractly, Nietzsche writes:

The human is the beastly animal and super animal; the higher human being is the inhuman and superhuman being: these belong together. [Der Mensch ist das Unthier und Überthier; der

höhere Mensch ist der Unmensch und Übermensch: so gehört es zusammen.) With each increase in the greatness and stature of the human being, so increases the depth and terribleness as well: one ought not will the one without the other – or rather: the more fully the one is willed, so then does one more

fully achieve precisely the other. (CW 17, 9[154]).°

Notice that in 77 "Forays" 37 (see Appendix), Nietzsche refers to Cesare Borgia only as a kind of superhuman being (eine Art Übermensch), and then only when considered in relation to human-kind as a whole (im Verhältniss zur Gesamt-Menschheit). Nietzsche's point is that Borgia was only superhuman in an analogical and comparative sense. Nietzsche reinforces this last point when he also describes Borgia in these passages as a superior human being (ein höherer Mensch) or as a superior kind of human being (eine höhere Art Mensch) – meaning that, despite his superior abilities and his superior value, he was still human. This latter description is especially significant because it alludes back to Nietzsche's Zarathustran concept and narrative theme of superior human beings (höhere Menschen). In his speech devoted to this concept, Zarathustra tells the assembled superior men that God is dead and that they should no longer feel constrained by the prevailing dogma of human equality. He instructs them that the time has come for them to overthrow the long rule of the rabble and to take charge of the world (ZIV "On Superior 52. We cite this from George Leiner's translations from CW 17: Unpublished Fragments: Summer 1886–Fall 1887 (Stanford, CA: Stanford University Press, forthcoming), which at times differ from our own translation decisions in this and our other volumes, most notably here with respect to höher, which we translate as "superior."

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Humans" 1-3). Nevertheless, Zarathustra emphasizes, because the very greatest human beings are still failed and half-broken,

and because they all contain the rabble within themselves, they are not his true concern. They can only prepare the way,

and eventually sacrifice themselves, for the sake of his only

true concern, the future superhumans. Here are the two key passages:

"You may indeed be superior humans, collectively,"

Zarathustra continued. "But for me – you are not superior and strong enough [.. .]

Nor are you beautiful enough for me and wellborn. I need clean, smooth mirrors for my teachings; on your surfaces my own image is still distorted.

Your shoulders are weighed down by many a burden, many a memory; in your corners many a wicked dwarf crouches. There is hidden rabble in you as well.

And even if you are superior and of a superior kind: much in you is crooked and deformed. There's no smith in the world who could hammer you smooth and straight for me."

(ZIV "The Welcoming")

Those who care the most ask today: "how will human beings survive?" But Zarathustra is the only one and the first

to ask: "how shall human beings be overcome?"

The superhumans are dear to me, they are my first and only concern, – and not humans [Der Übermensch liegt mir am Herzen, der ist mein Erstes und Einziges, – und nicht der Mensch]: not our neighbors, not the poorest people, not those

who suffer the most, not the best people –

Oh my brothers, what I am able to love in humans

is that they are a passing-over and a passing-away [Oh meine Briider, was ich lieben kann am Menschen, das ist, dass er ein

Übergang ist und ein Untergang). (ZIV "On Superior Humans" 3).

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Thus, when we read Nietzsche's post-Zarathustra remarks about

superior individuals like Borgia who actually existed in the past,

we should keep in mind his sharp distinction between any such

human beings and future superhumans. This sharp distinction applies even to Nietzsche's suggestion in AC 4 (see Appendix)

that superior human individuals like Borgia may continue to emerge in the future. And it applies as well to his suggestion in the same text that such cases of great success may even consist in whole families (like the Renaissance Borgias), tribes (like the Huns or the Visigoths), or peoples (like the ancient Greeks and Romans). Whether emerging in the future or consisting of more than just a single individual, the bull's-eye will still be human and is therefore excluded from Nietzsche's new and original philosophical concept of superhumans. Although Nietzsche does not similarly qualify his description in GM 116 (see Appendix) of Napoleon as a synthesis of inhuman and superhuman qualities, he does explicitly introduce him as the most late-born human being (Mensch). This careful description should be contrasted with Zarathustra's pre-vision of a figure who is no longer human (nicht mehr Mensch) and who laughs with a laughter that is not human (das keines Menschen Lachen war) (Z III "On the Vision and Riddle" 2). This description of Napoleon should also be read alongside Zarathustra's crucial claim that a superhuman being has never yet existed (Niemals noch gab es einen Übermenschen; ZI "On Priests").^o This is a point that Nietzsche brings up several times GM II 24-25 and in EH that he designed his character Zarathustra's speeches and life story to express important and difficult truths that he himself was not strong or healthy enough to express in his own voice in his later nonfictional works. See chapter 8 of Paul S. Loeb, *The Death of Nietzsche's Zarathustra* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2010); and Paul S. Loeb, "Ecce Superhomo: How Zarathustra Became What Nietzsche Was Not," in *Nietzsche's "Ecce Homo,"* ed. Duncan Large and Nicholas Martin (Berlin: Walter de Gruyter, forthcoming).

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in his preparatory notes (10[37], 10[41], 13[26]). In the immediate context of this claim, Zarathustra concedes to his disciples that great men have certainly existed in the past. But he warns his disciples to free themselves of their influence because, when seen stripped of their moral pretensions, even these greatest of individuals are all-too-human (allzumenschlich) and therefore still too closely related to the rabble and the puniest of human beings. This is why Nietzsche has Zarathustra cry out in despair toward the end of the published book:

I had once seen them both naked, the greatest human beings and the puniest human beings: all too similar to one another, – even the greatest still all too human! The greatest all too puny! – This is how I became sick and tired of human beings! (Z III “The Convalescent” 2)

Some of Nietzsche’s other remarks about Napoleon provide evidence that he includes even him in this observation. For example:

There are manners of the spirit by which even great spirits betray that they stem from rabble or semi-rabble: – for it is the gait and stride of their thoughts that betray them; they cannot walk. Thus, to his deep frustration, Napoleon himself could not walk like a prince and “legitimately” on those occasions when one really must know how, as in great coronation processions and the like: even there he was always merely the lead in a column – proud and hasty at the same time and very self-conscious of it. (JS 282)

In this way, then, Nietzsche is actually employing his new and original Zarathustran use of the term *Übermensch* to criticize the historically earlier tradition of using this term to refer to individual human beings who have superior abilities and superior value in relation to most other human beings. Indeed,

it is
 noteworthy that Nietzsche singles out the figure of Napoleon
 as the best instance his age has to offer of a superior in-
 dividual
 who is a kind of superhuman compared to all other human
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 beings. Here Nietzsche lets his readers know that he is in-
 herit-
 ing and superseding an earlier Romantic tradition that valo-
 rized heroic individuals – especially the contemporaneous
 Napoleon. In particular, Nietzsche is concerned to appropri-
 ate
 and criticize the language and ideas of two of the most im-
 portant
 figures in this earlier tradition: Thomas Carlyle and Johann
 Wolfgang
 von Goethe.
 The British author Carlyle was best known in Nietzsche's
 time
 for his 1841 collection of lectures, *On Heroes, Hero-Wor-
 ship, and
 the Heroic in History*. In this book, Carlyle inaugurated
 what is
 now called the great man theory of history, which he intro-
 duces
 as follows:
 For, as I take it, Universal History, the history of what
 man
 has accomplished in this world, is at bottom the History of
 the Great Men who have worked here. They were the leaders
 of men, these great ones; the modellers, patterns, and in a
 wide sense creators, of whatsoever the general mass of men
 contrived to do or to attain; all things that we see stand-
 ing
 accomplished in the world are properly the outer material
 result, the practical realization and embodiment, of
 Thoughts
 that dwelt in the Great Men sent into the world: the soul of
 the whole world's history, it may justly be considered, were
 the history of these.*
 Having claimed that the history of the world is the bio-
 graphy
 of great men (p. 13), Carlyle argues that these great men
 have
 always been worshipped in the past and that this hero wor-
 ship

is the bedrock of all human life:

Yes, from Norse Odin to English Samuel Johnson, from the divine Founder of Christianity to the withered Pontiff of Encyclopedism, in all times and places, the Hero has been worshipped. It will ever be so. We all love great men; love, venerate and bow down submissive before great men: nay can

54. Thomas Carlyle, *On Heroes, Hero-Worship, and the Heroic in History*

(Berkeley: University of California Press, 1993), 3.

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we honestly bow down to anything else? Ah, does not every true man feel that he is himself made higher by doing reverence to what is really above him? No nobler or more blessed feeling dwells in man's heart. And to me it is very cheering to consider that no sceptical logic, or general triviality, insincerity and aridity of any Time and its influ-

ences can destroy this noble inborn loyalty and worship that is in man. In times of unbelief, which soon have to become times of revolution, much down-rushing, sorrowful decay and ruin is visible to everybody. For myself in these days, I

seem to see in this indestructibility of Hero-worship the everlasting adamant lower than which the confused wreck of revolutionary things cannot fall. The confused wreck of things crumbling and even crashing and tumbling all round us in these revolutionary ages, will get down so far; no farther.

It is an eternal corner-stone, from which they can begin to build themselves up again. That man, in some sense or other, worships Heroes; that we all of us reverence and must ever reverence Great Men: this is, to me, the living rock amid all

rushings-down whatsoever;—the one fixed point in modern revolutionary history, otherwise as if bottomless and shoreless."

In response to this argument, and also to Carlyle's concluding

account of Napoleon as the most recent heroic great man, Nietzsche-

sche wrote an extended critique of what he called "the hero-cult

and its fanatics" (*Der Heroen-Cultus und seine Fanatiker*).

In the

final remarks of this critique, Nietzsche associates Napoleon,

Carlyle, and Romanticism:

People of this sort lived, for example, around Napoleon: indeed,

perhaps it was precisely he who introduced into the soul of our

century the Romantic prostration before the "genius" and the "h »

ero," a prostration alien to the spirit of the Enlightenment, he

of whom a Byron was not ashamed to say, he was a "worm compared with such a being." (The formulas for such prostration

were founded by that presumptuous old muddle- and surly-head,

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Thomas Carlyle, who spent a long life trying to make reason romantic for his fellow Englishmen: to no avail!) (D 298)

Unlike Carlyle, Nietzsche is not inspired by Napoleon's existence-

tence to go along with his century's Romantic idea of worshipping-

superior individuals. Indeed, this is the whole point of

his new philosophical concept of superhumans, and this is why, in the passage from EH ("Books" 1; see Appendix), Nietzsche-

sche dismisses those readers who have recognized Carlyle's "hero

cult" in his word *Übermensch*.°

The other crucial figure regarded by Nietzsche as playing a key role in the earlier Romantic tradition is Goethe. He was almost universally venerated in Nietzsche's time as the greatest

German poet." It is an interesting fact that Goethe thought highly of Carlyle and of his hero-worship lectures, whereas Nietzsche dismissed Carlyle but had the greatest admiration for Goethe. Indeed, it is obvious that Nietzsche considered Goethe to be one of the superior individuals (77 "Forays" 48-

51). So when Nietzsche writes about Goethe's admiration for Napoleon, he makes it clear that this is not some kind of pros-

tration or hero worship but rather the kind of respect that one

great man extends another:

What is certain is that it was not the "Wars of Liberation"

that

caused him to perk up, no more so than the French Revolution – no, the event for whose sake he rethought his Faust and

in fact the whole problem of being “human” [das ganze Problem

“Mensch” was the appearance of Napoleon. (BGE 244)

56. For a useful discussion of Nietzsche’s understanding and criticisms

of Carlyle’s lecture series, see William Meakins, “Nietzsche, Carlyle, and

Perfectionism,” *Journal of Nietzsche Studies* 45 (2014): 258-78.

57. We use the term “Romantic” in the sense that Nietzsche understood

it. British Germanists and some prominent American Goethe scholars, such

as Jane K. Brown, see Goethe as a Romantic poet. But German Germanists

and some of their American students use Goethe’s life as the template for the

literary periodization of his time, whereby he moves from “Storm and Stress”

(Sturm und Drang) in his early work through (neo)classical to his status as

one of the great poets of the Western tradition. According to the German

scheme, Goethe rejects both early and late Romanticism as pathological.

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And similarly:

In the midst of an age disposed to unreality, Goethe was a convinced realist: he said yes to all that was related to him in

this respect – he had no greater experience than that ens realissimum called Napoleon. (TI “Forays” 50)

Nevertheless, and this is a point missed by most scholars, it is

Nietzsche’s considered view that Goethe, like Napoleon and like all other great men, was still human-all-too-human and therefore not so different after all from the puniest of human

beings. Just as Nietzsche ridicules Napoleon’s ignoble gait in JS

\$282, cited above, so too he repeatedly makes fun of Goethe’s

penchant for having his heroic figures, such as Werther or Faust,
 fall into worshipful Romantic prostration before some puny
 embodiment of "the Eternal Feminine" (das Ewig-Weibliche; Z
 I "On Poets"; BGE 236). For example:
 This century loves to ascribe to its most intellectual men a
 taste for immature, mentally deficient and modest little
 girls
 of the people, Faust's taste for Gretchen – this speaks
 against
 the taste of the century and its most intellectual men.
 (5[1] 17;
 see also ZI "On Child and Marriage")
 Hence, Nietzsche explains, Goethe's Faust, which is supposed
 to
 be a tragedy of knowledge, actually makes him laugh (3[1]
 406):
 The Faust idea. – A little seamstress is seduced and made
 unhappy; a great scholar of all four branches of learning is
 the
 evil-doer. Can such unnatural things happen: No, certainly
 not! Without the assistance of the devil in person, the
 great
 scholar would not have brought it about. – Is this really
 supposed to be the greatest German "tragic idea," as we hear
 the Germans say? (WS 124)
 Thus, when Nietzsche deploys his new philosophical concept
 of
 superhumans, we should notice that this is his way of criti-
 ciz-
 ing and dismissing even the figure of Goethe, who as a young
 man loomed so large in the proto-Romantic "Storm and Stress"
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 movement and whose turn toward classical genres was
 signaled,
 in part, by the versification and completion of Faust I.
 What
 this means more specifically is that Nietzsche intends his
 new
 Zarathustran concept as a criticism of Goethe's ironic use
 of the
 term *Übermensch* in the "study" scene of Faust I. Some schol-
 ars
 have argued that Nietzsche's Zarathustran concept of superhu-
 mans
 is a conscious adaptation of Goethe's *Urfaust* invention?

But a more careful analysis shows that Nietzsche regards Goethe's concept as applying merely to a superior individual, someone like Borgia or Napoleon or even Goethe himself; who is only a kind of superhuman when compared to most other human beings. Obviously Goethe wants his readers to marvel at Faust's stupendous abilities and superior value, which is why he has Faust take seriously the Earth Spirit's mocking description of him as a superhuman (Faust 1:489--90). But Nietzsche points to Goethe's taste in women and his ridiculous "Faust-Idea" as a demonstration of Goethe's own failed and puny human nature and as further proof that even the greatest of human beings who have been called superhuman must now be overcome and superseded by true superhumans. The evidence we have presented here contradicts in many ways the reading of Nietzsche's term *Übermensch* that was first proposed by Walter Kaufmann in his extremely influential study of Nietzsche's philosophy (first published in 1950).⁵⁸ According to Kaufmann, Nietzsche's Zarathustrian concept of superhumans is identical to his concept of superior individuals and is best exemplified by the figure of Goethe. But in arguing for this claim, Kaufmann ignores the development in Nietzsche's thinking and interprets the Zarathustrian concept by appeal to his earliest writings and to his final writings. Eliding the fact that Nietzsche had not yet conceived his concept of the superhumans, Kaufmann simply identifies it with the idea in *Unfashionable Observations* that the goal of humankind lies in its scattered and accidentally

58. Cf. Adrian Del Caro, "Zarathustra vs. Faust, or Anti-Ro-

mantic Rivalry
 among Superhumans," in Nietzsche on Art and Life, ed. Daniel
 Came (Oxford:
 Oxford University Press, 2014), 143-62.
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 emerging highest specimens and single great men (On the
 Util-
 ity and Liability of History for Life §9, [CW 2, 151];
 Schopenhauer
 as Educator §6 [CW 2, 215]). And dismissing the important
 qualifications and distinctions we have summarized above as
 "mattering little" Kaufmann simply identifies Nietzsche's
 Zarathustran concept of superhumans with his later discus-
 sion
 in GM, TI, AC, and EH (see Appendix) about scattered and
 accidentally emerging superior human beings (such as Goethe,
 Napoleon, and Caesar). With these identifications in mind,
 Kaufmann then offers his translation and interpretation of
 Nietzsche's Zarathustran use of the term *Übermensch*. Accord-
 ing to Kaufmann, it means "overman" in the sense that it
 refers to a great man like Goethe who has overcome
 (mastered,
 sublimated) his animality (his passions, instincts, im-
 pulses)
 and thereby attained self-mastery and become truly human.
 But this interpretation belongs more properly in a discus-
 sion
 of the concept of freedom proposed by Rousseau and Kant. It
 has nothing to do with Nietzsche's insistence that even the
 best human beings like Goethe are not good enough and must
 be superseded by future superhumans.
 As a final point for this section, we would like to note
 that
 there is some overlap between Nietzsche's supernatural and
 superior-individual uses of his concept of superhumans. This
 is because JS §143 aims to explain how the invention of
 superhumans and other supernatural beings was the medium
 whereby superior individuals were able to express their own
 idiosyncratic ideals in the social context of a hostile
 central
 morality that declared a single human norm for everyone. As
 Nietzsche writes:
 But beyond oneself and outside, in a distant superworld, one
 was permitted to see a plurality of norms: one god was not
 the
 denial or blasphemy against another god! Here for the first

time individuals were allowed, here for the first time the rights of individuals were respected. (/S 143)

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According to Nietzsche's theory, then, supernatural superhumans

were actually a projection of superior individuals. When people

worshipped these fantastical supernatural figures, they were indirectly

worshipping existing human beings in their midst.

This is

why superior individuals and their superior abilities seemed to

acquire a supernatural aura. Nietzsche had already made a similar

point in his earlier books about the widespread tendency to attribute

a supernatural status to superior individuals (the saint, the

genius, the prince) who displayed superhuman (übermenschlich)

qualities (HAH 1143, 164, 441, 461; WS 73, 190).

The Superior-Species Use

Nietzsche publicly unveiled his new and original concept of superhumans in August 1883 in the preface to part I of *Z*. He published this part on its own before he published parts II and

III in late 1883 and 1884, respectively, and before he published

the first collected edition of parts I-III in 1886. He had a private

printing of part IV distributed to a select group of individuals

in 1885 (which he later attempted to recall), but he never published

this part IV for the public and he did not include it in the 1886

collected edition of the book.®°

At the start of the narrative in this preface, Zarathustra descends from his mountain cave in order to impart the wisdom he has gathered in solitude for the past ten years. On the

60. In his influential commentary on *Z*, Nietzsche's Teaching (New Ha-

ven, CT: Yale University Press, 1986), 19-22, 181, 204, 257-58, Laurence

Lampert argues that Zarathustra abandons his Übermensch teaching as the narrative of Z progresses and that this teaching plays no role in Nietzsche's post-Zarathustra works. But Lampert draws a mistaken contrast between the introductory "linear" teaching of superhumans and the final "circular" teaching of eternal recurrence and fails to understand Nietzsche's account of the internal coherence between these two teachings. He also ignores important textual evidence from part IV of Z (which he calls an "after-thought") and from later texts such as GM (II:12, 16, 24-25) and EH ("Books" Z, Z, "Destiny" 5). See Loeb, *The Death of Nietzsche's Zarathustra*, 203-6 and chap. 8.

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way down, he encounters a hermit saint, and he is surprised to learn that the hermit hasn't yet heard the news that God is dead. Immediately following this important revelation, Zarathustra

proceeds to the town marketplace so as to begin his public teaching. In the first sentence of his first speech, Zarathustra

announces his new doctrine of superhumans. We have included the original German passages here, and in a few places

below, so that readers can follow Nietzsche's innovations: Ich lehre euch den Übermenschen. Der Mensch ist Etwas, das überwunden werden soll. Was habt ihr gethan, ihn zu überwinden?

Alle Wesen bisher schufen

etwas über sich hinaus: und ihr

wollt die Ebbe dieser grossen

Flut sein und lieber noch zum

Tiere zurückgehn, als den Menschen überwinden?

Was ist der Affe für den

Menschen? Ein Gelächter oder eine schmerzliche Scham. Und

ebendas soll der Mensch für den

Übermenschen sein: ein Gelächter oder eine schmerzliche Scham.

Ihr habt den Weg vom Wurm zum Menschen

gemacht, und Vieles ist in euch

noch Wurm. Einst wart ihr
 Affen, und auch jetzt ist der
 Mensch mehr Affe, als irgend ein Affe.
 I teach you about the superhumans.
 Humans are something that must be overcome. What
 have you done to overcome them?
 All creatures so far have created something beyond them-
 selves: and you want to be the ebb
 of this great flood and would even
 prefer to go back to being animals
 than to overcome humans?
 What are apes to humans?
 A laughing stock or a painful
 embarrassment. And that is
 precisely what humans will be to
 superhumans: a laughing stock or a painful embarrassment.
 You have made your way from
 worms to humans, and much in
 you is still worm. Once you were
 apes, and even now humans are
 more ape than any apes. (ZI
 "Preface" 3; see also 4[181] and s[1]
 255 in this volume)
 There are many clear indications in this key opening passage
 that Nietzsche is using the term *Übermenschen* to mean a new
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 and future species that will be superior to the human spe-
 cies.
 He compares superhumans to the human species as well as to
 two animal species, apes and worms. Just as humans have
 made their way from apes and worms, so, too, superhumans
 might make their way from humans. Just as all creatures so
 far
 have created something beyond themselves, so, too, humans
 should aim to create something beyond themselves, namely,
 superhumans. If they do not choose this goal or if they do
 not
 succeed in this goal, humans will be the ebb in the great
 flood
 of creation, and they will go back to being animals. In or-
 der
 to achieve this goal, humans will have to overcome them-
 selves. At this future point in time, superhumans will be supe-
 rior to humans, just as humans are now superior to the two
 animal species, apes and worms. Superhumans will regard

humans as a laughingstock or a painful embarrassment, just as humans (who are even now more ape than any apes) regard apes in this way.

Although this passage does not explicitly refer to superhumans

as a species (in the sense that humans, apes, or worms are usually characterized as species), there is a place later in the

book where Zarathustra again warns his disciples about the possibility that humans might go back to being animals. He calls this potential movement "degeneration" (Entartung) – a term that for him signifies the stagnation and decay of the

species (Art). By contrast, he says, he is concerned to teach

them about an upward movement from species (Art) to super-species (Über-Art) – an obvious reference back to his introductory teaching of an upward movement from humans to superhumans:

Tell me, my brothers: what do we regard as bad and most bad? Is it not degeneration? – And where the bestowing soul is lacking we always infer degeneration.

Upward goes our way, from species over to super-species.

(ZI "On the Virtue of Gift-Giving" 1)

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Even more explicitly, Nietzsche wrote the following preparatory note in which he envisioned the future coexistence of the

human species with a new godlike superhuman species. Here he calls the superhumans a species (Art) in the same sense that

humans are a species:

Meine Forderung: Wesen hervorzubringen, welche über der ganzen Gattung "Mensch" erhaben dastehen: und diesem Ziele sich und "die Nächsten" zu opfern.

Die bisherige Moral hatte ihre Grenze innerhalb der Gattung: alle bisherigen Moralen waren nützlich, um der Gattung zuerst unbedingte Haltbarkeit zu geben: wenn diese erreicht ist, kann das Ziel höher genommen werden.

Die eine Bewegung ist unbedingt: die Nivellierung der Menschheit, große Ameisen- Bauten usw. (Dühring zu charakterisieren als außerordentlich ärmlich und typisch-gering, trotz seinen pathetischen Worten)

Die andere Bewegung: meine Bewegung: ist umgekehrt die Verschärfung aller Gegensätze und Klüfte, Beseitigung der

Gleichheit, das Schaffen Über-Mächtiger.

Jene erzeugt den letzten Menschen. Meine Bewegung den Übermenschen.

Es ist durchaus nicht das
Ziel, die letzteren als die Herren
der Ersteren aufzufassen:

My demand: to produce beings who stand sublimely above the
entire species "human being": and who sacrifice themselves
and "their neighbors" for this goal.

Morality up to now has had
its boundaries dictated by the
species: all moralities up to now
were useful for establishing first and foremost the unconditional
stability of the species: when this
has been achieved, the goal can
be set higher.

The one movement is unconditional: the leveling of human-
kind, giant ant hills etc. (Dühring to be characterized as
extraordinarily impoverished and typically narrow, despite
his lofty words)

The other movement: my movement: is conversely the intensi-
fication of all oppositions and divisions, elimination of
equality, the creation of the superpowerful.

The former generates last humans. My movement, superhumans.
The goal is not at all to

conceive of the latter as the
masters of the former: but

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sondern: es sollen zwei Arten rather: the two species should
neben einander bestehen – exist alongside one another –
möglichst getrennt; die eine as segregated as possible; the
one,

wie die epikurischen Götter, like the Epicurean gods, having
no

sich um die andere nicht concern for the other. (7[21]; see
kummernd. also 16[85], 35[73])

In this passage, Nietzsche distinguishes between two kinds
of

movement available to the still-fluid and as-yet-indetermin-
ate

human species (BGE 62; GM III 13). The first is a leveling
and

equalizing movement driven by human herd instincts that
aim to stabilize and fix the human species as much as pos-
sible.

The endpoint of this movement will be the “last humans” (der letzte Mensch) – meaning that humans will stop evolving because there will no longer be any chaos left within the species

driving it to create something beyond itself (ZI “Preface” 3).

Humans will have gone back to being animals because they will have the same fixed species nature as all other extant animal species that no longer aim at anything beyond their own herd survival and herd reproduction. In a preparatory note, Nietzsche explains this movement as a decision on the part of

humans to come to a standstill as super-apes and as an image of the last eternal humans: “Der Mensch bestimmt stehen zu bleiben, als der Übermensch, Bild des letzten Menschen, der der ewige

ist” (4[163]). It is noteworthy that he describes the no-longer-evolving humans as “super-apes” – thus suggesting again that the further evolution of humans will create a new species, the

superhumans. This other movement is the one Nietzsche advocates on behalf of superior individuals like himself who still feel this chaos within themselves and therefore aim to destabilize

the species as much as possible by intensifying any existing hostilities, inequalities, and power struggles (see also Z II “On Tarantulas”). This movement will be upward in the sense of producing superpowerful human beings who will stand above the whole human species and sacrifice themselves and others for the sake of creating a new and superior, godlike species, the

superhumans.

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Although Nietzsche draws an analogy here between superhumans and Epicurean gods, this passage and others like it show that Nietzsche's Zarathustran concept of superhumans has nothing in common

with his earlier philological concept of supernatural superhumans.

Indeed, as we have seen, Nietzsche contrasts these two concepts within the text of Z. In the chapter on poets, Zarathustra ridicules the poetic invention of fantastic superhuman beings living in castles on the clouds. But in this preface he articulates a completely immanent and naturalistic concept of superhumans. He has Zarathustra teach that superhumans will really exist in the future on the actual earth and that they will represent a further and superior stage in the development that has already taken place on the way from actually existing animal species like worms and apes to the actually existing human species.

It is also significant that Nietzsche introduces his new concept of superhumans with Zarathustra's revelation that God is dead. Later in Z Nietzsche extends this idea to all gods and presumably to all the supernatural entities that were associated with divinity in JS §143:

"All gods are dead: now we want superhumans to live." ["Todt sind alle Götter: nun wollen wir, dass der Übermensch lebe."| (Z I "On the Virtue of Gift-Giving" 3 see also ZIV "On Superior Humans" 2)

Thus, according to Nietzsche, the end of all belief in divinity and in supernatural superhumans is a precondition for the emergence of a new belief in the possibility of humans overcoming themselves and creating a superior species of superhumans. In an especially helpful later passage, Nietzsche contrasts humanity's very real ability to conceive and create this new species with the impossible task of conceiving and creating divinity:

Einst sagte man Gott, wenn People used to say God when

man auf ferne Meere blickte; they gazed out over distant seas;
nun aber lehrte ich euch sagen: yet now have taught you to say:

Übermensch. superhumans.

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Gott ist eine Muthmaassung;
aber ich will, dass euer Muth-
maassen nicht weiter reiche, als euer schaffender Wille.
Könntet ihr einen Gott schaffen? – So schweigt mir doch von
allen Göttern! Wohl aber könntet ihr den Übermen- schen
schaffen.

Nicht ihr vielleicht selber, meine Brüder! Aber zu Vätern
und Vorfahren könntet ihr euch umschaffen des Übermenschen:
und Diess sei euer bestes Schaffen! –

Gott ist eine Muthmaassung:

aber ich will, dass euer Muth-
maassen begrenzt sei in der Denkbarekeit.

Könntet ihr einen Gott denken? – Aber diess bedeute euch
Wille zur Wahrheit, dass Alles verwandelt werde in Menschen-
Denkbares, Men- schen-Sichtbares, Men- schen-Fühlbares! Eure
eignen

Sinne sollt ihr zu Ende denken!

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God is a conjecture; but I
don't want your conjecturing to extend further than your
creating will.

Couldyou create agod? – Then don't you dare speak
to me of any gods! But you
could certainly create superhumans.

Perhaps not you yourselves, my brothers! But you could re-
create yourselves into fathers and forefathers of superhu-
mans:

and let this be your best
creating! –

God is a conjecture: but I want your conjecturing
to be limited to what is
conceivable.

Could you conceive a god?

– But this is what the will to
truth should mean to you, that
everything be transformed into what is humanly conceivable,
humanly visible, humanly tangible! You should think your
own senses all the way through
to their conclusion! (Z II "Upon
the Blessed Isles")

Nietzsche comments here that people used to dream about impossible supernatural beings. But now they need to be taught to think realistically about how they can re-create themselves into ancestors of a future superhuman species. In a couple of brief preparatory notes, he goes further than this

and suggests that previous human dreams of supernatural beings were actually a product of humankind's dissatisfaction

with itself and of its resulting desire to create a superior species

of superhumans:

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Unsere Verachtung des Our contempt for h(umans)

M(enschen) trieb uns hinter die drove us beyond the stars. Sterne. Religion, Metaphysik, als Religion, metaphysics, as Symptom einer Begierde, den symptom of a desire to create Übermenschen zu schaffen. superhumans. (4[214])

Ich betrachte alle metaphy- I regard all metaphysical and sischen und religiösen Denk- religious modes of thought as weisen als Folge einer Unzufrie- results of a dissatisfaction with

denheit am Menschen eines humans, of a drive for a superior, Triebes nach einer höheren, superhuman future – except übermenschlichen Zukunft – that humans wanted to flee into nur daß die Menschen sich ins the beyond: instead of building

Jenseits flüchten wollten: statt an on the future. A misunderstanding-

der Zukunft zu bauen. Ein ing on the part of superior Mißverständniß der höheren natures who suffer on account of Naturen, die am häßlichen Bilde the ugly image of human beings.

des Menschen leiden. (CW₁, 27[74])

These unpublished fragments are especially interesting because they offer Nietzsche's background thinking when he has Zarathustra declare, right after announcing his new teaching,

that his listeners should want superhumans to be the meaning of the earth:

I implore you, my brothers, remain faithful to the earth and do not believe those who speak to you of extraterrestrial

hopes! [...]

I love those who do not first seek behind the stars for a reason to perish and be a sacrifice: who instead sacrifice

themselves for the earth, so that the earth may one day belong to superhumans [dass die Erde einst der Übermenschen werde). (ZI "Preface" 3-4; cf. also ZI "On the Virtue of Gift-Giving" 2 and 5[17])

These collected passages also show that Nietzsche's new Zarathustra-

concept of superhumans has nothing to do with the Romantic concept of superior individuals. Whereas the former is entirely directed toward the far future, the latter is inspired

by the historical past. Whereas the former envisions something

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that has never yet existed, the latter idolizes famous instances of

past existence. And whereas the former imagines a new species

that will be superior to all human beings, the latter glorifies the

greatest human specimens, who are nevertheless still puny by virtue of being human. Again, Nietzsche contrasts these two concepts within the text of Z.

Niemals noch gab es einen A superhuman being has Übermenschen. Nacktsah ich never yet existed. I saw both Beide, den grössten und den naked, the greatest and the kleinsten Menschen: – puniest human beings: –

Allzuähnlich sind sie They are all too similar to noch einander. Wahrlich, one another. Truly, I found even auch den Grössten fand ich – the greatest – all too human! allzumenschlich! (Z II "On Priests")

Ihr höchsten Menschen, You most superior human denen mein Auge begegnete! das beings whom I have ever laid ist mein Zweifel an euch und eyes on! this is my doubt about mein heimliches Lachen: ich you and my secret laughter: I rathe, ihr würdet meinen suspect you would call my Übermenschen – Teufel heissen! superhumans – devils!

Ach, ich ward dieser Oh, I became weary of these Höchsten und Besten müde: aus most superior and best human ihrer "Höhe" verlangte mich beings: from their "pinnacle" I hinauf, hinaus, hinweg zudem was compelled upward, outward, Übermenschen! and away to superhumans!

Ein Grausen überfiel mich, I was overcome with dread als ich diese Besten nackt sah: when I saw these best human

da wuchsen mir die Flügel, beings naked: then I sprouted fortzuschweben in ferne wings to soar away into distant

Zukiinfte. futures.

In fernere Zukiinfte, in Into more distant futures,
südlichere Süden, als je ein into more southern souths than
Bildner träumte: dorthin, wo any artist ever dreamed: there,
Götter sich aller Kleider where gods are ashamed of all
schämen! clothing! (Z II "On Human
Prudence")

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In part IV, Nietzsche depicts Zarathustra's interactions
with a
collection of diverse superior men who are modeled on actual
men who were famous during Nietzsche's time, some of whom
played an important role in his own development: Napoleon
(the
kings), Tolstoy (the voluntary beggar), Schopenhauer (the
sooth-
sayer), Wagner (the sorcerer), Paul Rée (the leech-brain ex-
pert),
Lord Byron (the shadow), and David Strauss (the ugliest
man).

Here Nietzsche offers an extensive catalogue of all the
various
ways in which these superior men are lacking because aspects
of
them still belong to the herd, the mob, and the rabble (as
sym-
bolized by their long-eared companion, the ass). In his
speech
welcoming these superior men to his mountain cave, Zarathus-
tra tells them that they are not strong, healthy, beautiful,
or
wellborn enough for him and that they are not the ones to
whom
his heritage and name belong. Only his chosen disciples, the
ones he calls his children, the ones who will become ancest-
ors of
the superhumans, the ones he calls his new beautiful species
(meine neue schöne Art), are entitled to his name and his
heritage
(Z IV "The Welcoming"). Similarly, in his speech to the as-
sem-
bled superior men about his concept of superior human be-
ings,
Zarathustra urges them to help him create superhumans, since
these are his first and only concern – not humans, not even
the

very best among them (ZIV "On Superior Humans" 1-2). In these passages, then, Nietzsche invents a new use for the term *Übermensch* that had never before appeared in his own writings or in the history of German thought. Looking back at his introduction of this new use in part I of *Z*, it is not difficult to guess the stimulus for this invention. As commentators have noted from the start, what is most striking about this introduction is Nietzsche's clear and direct allusion to Darwinism, which he later calls "the last great scientific movement" (JS 357).

Thomas Brobjer, *Nietzsche and the "English": The Influence of British and American Thinking on His Philosophy* (New York: Humanity Books, 2008), 235-71.

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Most obviously, Nietzsche writes that humans were once apes and that as a consequence they now regard apes with a feeling of painful embarrassment. This is the most famous image associated with Darwinism at the time Nietzsche was writing. Ten years earlier, in his first published text after *BT*;

Nietzsche had alluded to this image in his polemical confrontation with David Friedrich Strauss's influential book *The Old Faith and the New: A Confession*. Although Strauss claimed to replace Christianity with Darwinism, Nietzsche argued that he refused to acknowledge the radical consequences of Darwinism. Referring to Strauss's chapter titled "Apes and Humans: Darwin on the Descent of Humans from Apes"

("Affe und Mensch: Darwin über die Affenabstammung des Menschen"), Nietzsche wrote:

With a certain crude contentment [Strauss] covers himself with the shaggy cloak of our ape-genealogists and praises Darwin as one of humankind's greatest benefactors ... (HL 7, CW 2, 39, lines 1-4)

In later years, Nietzsche encountered this same famous image in some of his most closely studied readings. For example, his philosophical partner, Paul Rée, had singled out this image

in
his brief introduction to. The Origin of Moral Feelings.
After
writing that Darwin's discovery of the theory of evolution
now enabled us to trace moral phenomena back to natural
causes, Rée summarized this theory in a single proposition:
This natural explanation is fundamentally based on the
proposition: The higher animals have evolved from the lower
by means of natural selection, humans from apes.
Writing during his stay with Rée in Sorrento, Nietzsche in-
cludes
the following observation in HAH. Here Nietzsche anticipates
62. David Friedrich Strauss, Der Alte und der Neue Glaube:
Ein Bekennt-
nis (Leipzig: S. Hirzel, 1872).
Ernst Schmeitzner, 1877).
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Zarathustra's claim that humans once were apes and might
even
return to being animals – unless they act to avoid this
fate:
The whole of humanity is perhaps only a developmental phase
of a certain animal species of limited duration: so that hu-
man
beings came from apes and will again become apes, while
there is nobody who takes any interest whatsoever in this
wonderful comic ending [. . .] the decline of universal
world
culture might some day lead to an even more heightened
repulsiveness and eventual bestialization of humanity to the
point of apishness. – Precisely because we can envision this
perspective, we are perhaps in a position to prevent the fu-
ture
from reaching such an end. (HAH 247)
Finally, writing just a few years later, Nietzsche anticip-
ates
Zarathustra's remark that humans feel painful embarrassment
when confronted with the news of their evolutionary origins
in apes and other animals. But he is much less optimistic
about the possibility of humans achieving any kind of gran-
deur in their evolutionary future:
The new fundamental feeling: our permanent transitoriness. –
Formerly one tried to get a feel for the majesty of human
beings by pointing backward toward their divine descent:
this
has now become a forbidden path, because before its gate

stands the ape along with other heinous beasts, grinning knowingly as if to say: no farther here in this direction.

So,

one has a go of it now from the opposite direction: the path humanity pursues shall serve as proof of its majesty and kinship to God. Alas, this too leads nowhere! At the end of this path stands the funeral urn of the /ast human and gravedigger (with the inscription "nihil humani a me alienum puto"). However high humanity may have evolved – and perhaps at the end it will be standing even lower than at the

beginning! – there is in store for humanity no more a transformation into a higher order than for the ant and the earwigs, which, at the end of their "earthly days," will not
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ascend to kinship with God and eternal life. The Becoming dragsthe Has Been along behind it: why should an exception to this eternal spectacle be made for some little planet and again for some little species on it! Away with such senti-

men-
talities! (D 49)

On a more abstract level, Nietzsche's introduction of his new

concept of superhumans at the start of part I of Z includes several background principles that he regards as advances made by the Darwinist scientific movement:

No living species, not even the human species, has been divinely created.

No living species, not even the human species, is eternal or immutable.

Instead, all living species, including the human species, are a product of natural evolution.

All living species, including the human species, are transitory, impermanent, and subject to flux. They have an evolutionary origin, are capable of evolutionary change, and may be subject to evolutionary extinction.

All living species, including the human species, are interrelated and evolutionarily descended from other living species.

The human species is an animal species.

The human species is evolutionarily descended from an ancestor that is shared by the simpler and more primitive ape species. Therefore, the human species shares traits with the ape species.

In terms of geological chronology, all the animal species, including the human species, share evolutionary

ancestors with far simpler and more primitive animal species, such as invertebrate animal species like the worm. Therefore, the human species shares traits with the worm species.

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Clearly, then, Nietzsche's invention of a new philosophical concept of superhumans was made possible by his sympathetic reception of the contemporaneous Darwinist movement. Because of this movement, he was able to conceive the idea that humans might be capable of further evolution and even create a better species.⁶⁴

However, this doesn't mean that Nietzsche's new concept is Darwinist. In fact, when reviewing his accomplishments in EH, Nietzsche singles out for scorn the "learned cattle" who suspect him of Darwinism on account of his concept of superhumans (EH "Books" 1; see Appendix). The reason for this is, again, easy to find in his introduction of this concept in

part I of Z. For nowhere here does Nietzsche mention Darwin's theory, cited above by Paul Rée, that natural selection is

the means whereby species evolve. Instead, Zarathustra says that all living creatures so far, except humans, have created

something beyond themselves and that they have done so by overcoming themselves. Whereas all other living creatures are

clearly exceeded by humans, humans are not exceeded by anything else on earth (Z II "On Old and New Tablets" 23). So in

64. Nevertheless, there are scholars who write about the topic of Nietz-

sche and Darwinism but continue to interpret the *Übermensch* as a kind of

superior (male) individual. Cf. Dirk R. Johnson, *Nietzsche's Anti-Darwinism*

(Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2010), 57-60, 64-66, 77; John

Richardson, *Nietzsches New Darwinism* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2004), 209.

65. In his commentary, Kaufmann acknowledges "the plain fact" that,

despite Nietzsches remark in EH, his introduction of Zarathustra's
 Uebermensch teaching invites a Darwinist interpretation (Nietzsche: Philosopher, Psychologist, Antichrist, 311-13). But instead of exploring this connection further, Kaufmann resorts to Nietzsche's much earlier text, UO, in order to claim that this teaching concerns only his admiration for superior individuals like Goethe. In an especially far-fetched exegetical argument, Kaufmann claims that the reason Nietzsche dismissed the Darwinist interpretation is that he expected his readers to construe Zarathustra's simile of the ape by recalling his much earlier remark that "the philosophers, artists, and saints" are "truly human beings and no-longer-animals" (SE 5).

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order for humans to create something that exceeds them, that is, the superhumans, they will have to overcome themselves. Here Nietzsche anticipates the new teaching that Zarathustra will unveil in part II of the book, in the key chapter titled

"On Self-Overcoming." In this chapter, Nietzsche simply dismisses what was then the most famous aspect of Darwin's theory of natural selection, indeed the aspect mentioned in the title of his book – namely, his doctrine of the struggle for

existence or the struggle for life (Kampf um's Dasein, Kampf um's Leben).°° He then replaces it with his own new doctrine of the struggle for power:

"He who shot at the truth with the phrase 'will to existence'

certainly did not hit it: this will – does not exist!

"For: that which is not cannot will; yet what is in existence,

how could this still will to exist!

"Only where there is life, is there also will: but not will to

live, instead – thus I teach you – will to power

"Much is esteemed more highly by the living than life itself; yet out of esteeming itself there speaks – the will to

power!" (See also BGE 13; JS 349; TI "Forays" 14)

In this speech, Nietzsche argues against Darwin that living creatures do not compete for survival; they do so in order to

gain power. But this raises the question as to how Nietzsche can offer an alternative naturalistic explanation of the newly

demonstrated fact that species evolve. In Darwin's view, the struggle for existence plays an essential role. Those living crea-

tures whose randomly acquired heritable variations do not offer

them an advantage in adapting to their environment will lose this struggle against their competitors and will be selected out of

existence – thus leaving their competitors to flourish and evolve.

For Nietzsche, however, the answer lies in his claim that living

66. Charles Darwin, *On the Origin of Species by Means of Natural Selec-*

tion, or the Preservation of Favored Races in the Struggle for Life (London:

John Murray, 1859).

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creatures value power more than survival. This means that they

are even willing to risk their survival and select themselves out of

existence, if this will make them feel more powerful. Nietzsche

calls this process "life's selfovercoming":

Wherever I found living creatures, there I found will to power; and even in the will of those serving I found the will

to be master.

That the weaker should serve the stronger, of this they are persuaded by their will, which wants to be master over what is weaker still: this is the one pleasure they cannot renounce.

And just as the lesser surrender to the greater, in order that

they may take pleasure in their power over the least: in this

way even the greatest may still surrender and for the sake of

power wager – life itself [...]

The surrender of the greatest is this, that there is risk and

danger and a death-defying roll of the dice [...]

And life itself told me this secret. "Behold," it spoke, "I am

that which must always overcome itself.

"Of course you call it will to reproduce or drive to a purpose, to something higher, more distant, more manifold: but all this is one, and one secret.

"I will rather perish than renounce this one thing; and truly, wherever there is downfall and the falling of leaves, behold, there life sacrifices itself – for power!" (Z II "On Self-Overcoming")

It is important to notice that Nietzsche's argument here focuses

only on those living creatures that are the most powerful and

whose dominance has left them no viable competitors in the universal struggle for power. But they want to feel more power

still, and so they are driven to create something greater beyond

themselves, that is, a future species that will be much more powerful than they are. They must therefore breed stronger offspring and then select themselves out of existence by seeking

the greatest risks and dangers – thus leaving their descendants

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to flourish and repeat the same cycle until eventually a new species has emerged. In this way, they are able to gain a plea-

surable feeling that their power extends far beyond the limits of

their own short lives and their current sphere of control.

In the preface to part I of Zarathustra, published twenty-four years after the appearance of Darwin's *On the Origin of Species*, Nietzsche has his protagonist announce to humans that it is time for them to set a goal and plant the seed of their

highest hope. This is because they have now attained their state of maximum power and no longer have any viable competitors on earth. As Zarathustra tells the superior men:

"What is farthest, deepest, highest to the stars in humans, their monstrous power [Des Menschen Fernstes, Tiefstes,

Sternen-

Hochstes, seine ungeheure Kraft|" (ZIV "On Superior Humans" 15). But they still have the drive for more power, or as Zarathustra

puts it in more poetic terms: their soil is still rich enough to

grow the tallest tree; the string of their bow is still tense enough

to launch the arrow of their longing beyond the human; they still have enough chaos within them to give birth to a dancing

star; and their cloud is still dark enough to discharge a bolt of

lightning. According to Nietzsche, what will motivate the most

powerful human beings into setting this goal is their dissatisfaction-

with humankind in general and even with themselves.

So Zarathustra encourages the most powerful human beings to intensify their feelings of self-contempt as much as possible. First,

he asks them to construct as their greatest experience the hour in

which they feel contempt for all those aspects of themselves that

they have previously valued: their happiness, reason, virtue, jus-

tice, and compassion. All of these should now be regarded as poverty, filth, and wretched contentment. Second, in a long passage modeled on the Bible's Sermon on the Mount, Zarathustra

asks the most powerful human beings to convert their intensified

feelings of self-contempt into an overwhelming desire to perish

and to sacrifice themselves for the sake of superhumans. And finally, recognizing that his recently educated audience may now

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feel too proud to accept his first two lessons, Zarathustra describes

for them the most contemptible kind of humans, the future last

humans, those whose will to power has declined to the point where they are no longer able to feel any self-contempt, where

they merely want to live as long and as contentedly as possible,
and where they merely blink at the idea of creating something
beyond themselves.

Nietzsche doesn't specifically mention the selective-breeding
aspect of his evolution theory in the "Preface" or in the
"On

Self-Overcoming" chapter of Z. Instead, he dwells on this
aspect when applying his theory to the human species in the
rest of the book and in his preparatory notes: "the humans
who

were overcome were themselves the fathers of superhumans
[der

überwundene Mensch selber war der Vater des Übermenschen]"
(18[56]; cf. also 15[4], 16[86]). Speaking to his chosen
disciples,

who have been repeatedly instructed that humans must be
overcome, Zarathustra teaches them to think of love, marriage,

and children as necessary steps on their way to becoming
ancestors of superhumans. Here are the relevant passages:

Bitterniss ist im Kelch auch

der besten Liebe: so macht sie

Sehnsucht zum Übermenschen,

so macht sie Durst dir, dem

Schaffenden!

Durst dem Schaffenden, Pfeil und Sehnsucht zum Über-

menschen: sprich, mein Bruder,

ist diess dein Wille zur Ehe?

Heilig heisst mir solch ein Wille und solche Ehe. –

Also rathe ich allen Redlichen;

und was wäre denn meine Liebe

zum Übermenschen und zu Allem, was kommen soll, wenn ich an-
ders riethe und redete!

There is bitterness in the cup
of even the best love: thus it
causes longing in you for super-
humans, thus it causes thirst in
you, the one who creates!

Thirst of the one who creates,
arrow and longing for superhu-
mans: speak, my brother, is this
your will to marriage?

Such a will and such a

marriage, I call these holy. – (Z
I “On Child and Marriage”)
Thus I counsel all honest
people; and what then would my
love for superhumans be, and for
all that is to come, if I counseled
and spoke otherwise!

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Nicht nur fort euch zu pflanzen, sondern hinauf
– dazu, oh meine Brüder, helfe
euch der Garten der Ehe!

Der Strahl eines Sternes glänze in eurer Liebe! Eure
Hoffnung heiße: “möge ich den Übermenschen gebären!”
Ihr Einsamen von heute, ihr Ausscheidenden, ihr sollt einst
ein Volk sein: aus euch, die ihr
euch selber auswähltet, soll ein auserwähltes Volk erwach-
sen:

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Not only to propagate yourselves further, but rather
upward – oh my brothers, may
the garden of marriage help you
in this! (ZIII “On Old and New
Tablets” 24)

Let the ray of a star shine in
your love! Let your hope be
called: “may I give birth to
superhumans!” (ZI “On Little Women, Old and Young”; see also
4[100])

You solitary ones of today, you
withdrawing ones, one day you
shall be a people: from you who
have chosen yourselves a chosen
people shall grow: – and from
– und aus ihm der

them the superhumans. (ZI “On Übermensch.
the Virtue of Gift-Giving” 2)

Many scholars have criticized Nietzsche for not understand-
ing

Darwin’s theory of evolution, or for offering flawed argu-
ments
against this theory, or for proposing an implausible altern-
ative
to this theory.” But they don’t really investigate his new
Zara-

thustran concept of superhumans as a superior species, and
they don’t see how this concept was his first and most im-

port-

ant public response to Darwin's theory. This concept would not

have been possible without Darwin's destruction of previous theologically based theories of eternal and immutable species.

It is true, of course, that in Darwin's account of environmentally

adaptive fitness there is no room for the idea of superior

and inferior species. But this point is also the inspiration for

Nietzsche's rejection of the previous theologically based consensus

that humankind is the peak of evolution (AC 14). By Cambridge University Press, 2002), 21-55.

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arguing against Darwin that living creatures struggle for power

instead of survival, Nietzsche is able to envision a species that

will be superior to humankind because it will be more powerful.

He is also able to modify Darwin's theory that species evolve

through natural selection with his claim that supremely dominant

species may risk their survival and select themselves out of

existence for the sake of obtaining still greater power. And whereas Darwin often depicts nature as a kind of agent of

artificial selection, Nietzsche locates this agency in the individual

members of these supremely dominant species as they aim to extend their power through their artificially selected progeny.

Because Nietzsche claims that his theory of evolution can explain everything that Darwin's theory explains (BGE 13), as

well as cases of self-sacrificing organisms that Darwin had trouble explaining, critics might want to respond that he is offering the wrong kind of explanation.[®] In particular, they might concede that Nietzsche's theory of evolution through selfovercoming and artificial selection could be a plausible account of how human beings would choose to create a supe-

rior species. However, because it appears to attribute purposive long-term planning to all living creatures, Nietzsche's theory would seem to be nothing more than an anthropomorphic projection onto nature. Nietzsche's rebuttal to this serious charge would explain how he is actually following Darwin in offering a strictly naturalistic account of future human evolution. He is not imbuing nature with mind but rather translating the human mind back into nature.[®] Just as Darwin proposes that all seemingly species-specific human behavior can be explained in terms of instincts that are shared with all other animal species, so too Nietzsche argues that the human longing to create superhumans

The Origin of Species: "I confine myself to one special difficulty, which at first appeared to me insuperable, and actually fatal to my whole theory."

Philosophy," in Nietzsche and the Philosophers, ed. Mark Conard (New York: Routledge, 2017), 9-39.

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should be explained in terms of an unconscious and irrational drive for power that they share with all other living creatures. This is why, for example, Nietzsche chooses the zoological language of "breeding" (Züchtung) to describe the human creation of superhumans. Indeed, he argues in his later works, it was actually Darwin who anthropomorphically projected into nature the struggle for existence that permeated his own Malthusian milieu of restricted will to power, overpopulation, and scarce resources (JS 349; TI "Forays" 14).[°]

Conclusion

Our goal in this Afterword has been to offer some helpful advice on Nietzsche's writing and philosophy in his 1882-84

notes. This advice is intended for English-speaking readers who are not fluent in German and are obliged to accept the expertise and wisdom of his translators. In terms of Nietzsche's writing, we have aimed to show in more detail than usual how he used the German language and how translators like us convert this stylistically complex and innovative usage into an accurate and readable English. We hope to have communicated the many complicated issues that any translator of Nietzsche must take into account and also to have demonstrated, through summary and examples, the principles that underlie our approach. In terms of his philosophy, we have concentrated on Nietzsche's invention in these notes of a new use for the German term *Übermensch*. Walter Kaufmann's vastly influential translations

70. A separate interpretive question concerns Nietzsche's view that no superhumans have ever existed despite the fact that human beings have always been engaged in practices of selective breeding. Why does Nietzsche think that this same practice, along with a focus on self-overcoming, should now lead to the creation of a superhuman species? The answer to this important question lies in Nietzsche's emphasis on Zarathustra's new teaching of eternal recurrence. See chapters 7 and 8 of Loeb, *The Death of Nietzsche's Zarathustra*; and Paul S. Loeb, "Nietzsche's Transhumanism: Evolution and Eternal Recurrence," in *Nietzsche and Transhumanism: Precursor or Enemy*, ed. Yunus Tuncel (Newcastle, UK: Cambridge Scholars, 2017), 83-100.

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and interpretations have led generations of translators and readers to suppose that Nietzsche's new use of this term referred merely to his admiration for extraordinary human individuals like Napoleon and Goethe. But we have argued here that close

attention to the linguistic, textual, and philosophical context of

Nietzsche's new use of the term *Übermensch* shows that he was inspired by Darwin's discoveries to conceive of the idea that

human beings might be driven by their tremendous will to power into creating a superior species that would relate to all

human beings, no matter how extraordinary, in the same way that humans now relate to apes.

Appendix

Appearances of the term *Übermensch* in

Nietzsche's published works following the publication of *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*

Like a final sign pointing to the other way Napoleon appeared,

the most singular and late-born human being [*Mensch*] there ever was, and in him the incarnate problem of the noble ideal

in itself – and consider well what kind of problem it is:

Napoleon, this synthesis of an inhuman and a superhuman

[*diese Synthesis von Unmensch und Übermensch*) . . . (GM 116)

As was to be expected, the whole ferocity of moral stultification

that, as we all know, passes for morality itself in Germany

many, was mobilized against my concept of "beyond good and evil"—: I could tell some pretty tales about that. Above all, I was asked to reflect on the "undeniable superiority" of

our time in its ethical judgment, the genuine progress we have

made here: in comparison with us, a Cesare Borgia should not be presented as a "superior human being" at all, as a kind of

superhuman being [*als ein "höherer Mensch," als eine Art Übermensch*], as I present him ... (TI "Forays" 37)

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Humanity does not represent a development for the better or the stronger or the superior in the way this is believed today. "Progress" is merely a modern idea, which is to say a false idea. The European of today remains, in terms of value,

deeply inferior to the European of the Renaissance; further development is absolutely or, by any form of necessity, enhancement, intensification, strengthening.

In another sense, in individual cases there is continual success in the most diverse places in the world and from the most diverse cultures where a superior type does in fact present

itself: something that is a kind of superhuman in relation to

humanity as a whole [etwas, das im Verhältniss zur Gesamtmenschheit eine Art Übermensch ist). Such serendipities of great

success have always been possible and perhaps will always be possible. And even whole families, tribes, and peoples can in

certain circumstances represent just such a lucky hit. (AC 4)

In the final analysis, this is my typical experience and, if you

prefer, the originality of my experience. Those who thought they had understood something by me fashioned something of me in their own image – not infrequently the opposite of me, for example, an “idealist”; those who understood nothing of me denied that I came into consideration at all. – The word “superhumans” [Das Wort “Übermensch”] to designate the type that has turned out best, in contrast to “modern” humans, to “good” humans, to Christians and other nihilists – a word that becomes, in the mouth of a Zarathustra, that destroyer of morality, a most thought-provoking word, is almost invariably, and completely innocently, understood in the sense of those values whose opposite was manifested in the

figure of Zarathustra, in other words, as the “idealistic” type

of a superior kind of human, half “saint,” half “genius” . . .

This has caused other learned cattle to suspect me of Darwin-

ism; they have even recognized in it the “hero cult,” so wickedly rejected by me, of Carlyle, that great unconscious, unintentional counterfeiter. When I whispered in someone’s

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ear that he should look around for a Cesare Borgia rather than a Parsifal, he could not believe his ears.”! (EH “Books” 1)

Here, at every moment, human beings are overcome, here the concept “superhumans” has become the highest reality – at an infinite distance beneath him lies everything that was ever

found great in the human being. [Hier ist in jedem Augen-
 blick
 der Mensch überwunden, der Begriff "Übermensch" ward hier
 höchste Realität, – in einer unendlichen Ferne liegt alles
 das,
 was bisher gross am Menschen hiess, unter ihm.) (EH "Books"
 Z)
 Zarathustra, the first psychologist of the good, is – there-
 fore
 – a friend of evil. When a decadence-kind of human has
 climbed to the rank of the most superior kind, this could
 only
 happen at the expense of their opposite kind, the strong
 kind
 of human confident about life. When the herd animal glows
 in the radiance of the purest virtue, the exceptional human
 must have been devalued into evil. When mendacity at any
 price appropriates the word "truth" for its perspective, a
 really
 truthful person must be relegated to the worst of names.
 Here, Zarathustra leaves no doubt: he says that his recogni-
 tion of the good, the "best," was exactly the thing that
 aroused his horror at the human in general; through this
 dislike, his wings had grown ready "to soar off to distant
 futures," – he does not conceal the fact that Ais type of
 human, a relatively superhuman type, is superhuman precisely
 in relation to the good people, and that the good and the
 just
 people would call his superhumans devils . . . [dass sein
 Typus
 71. See also Nietzsche's letter to Malwida von Meysenbug (20
 October
 1888, KGB III:s, 458): "– – for your own purposes, you have
 again – some-
 thing I never forgive – made my concept 'superhu-
 mans' [meinem Begriff
 "Übermensch"] into a 'more sophisticated sham,' into some-
 thing resembling
 sibyls and prophets: whereas every serious reader of my
 texts has to know
 that the one type of human being that cannot disgust me is a
 type com-
 pletely antithetical to the ideal-idols of yesteryear, a
 thousand times more
 similar to Cesare Borgia than to a Christ."
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Mensch, ein relativ übermenschlicher Typus, gerade im Verhält-

niss zu den Guten übermenschlich ist, dass die Guten und Gerechten seinen Übermenschen Teufel nennen würden . . .]

You most superior human beings whom I have ever laid eyes on! this is my doubt about you and my secret laughter: I suspect you would call my superhumans – devils! [ich rathe, ihr würdet meinen Übermenschen – Teufel heissen!)

You are so alienated from greatness with souls like yours, that you would find superhumans terrifying in their goodness . . . [So fremd seid ihr dem Grossen mit eurer Seele, dass euch der Übermensch furchtbar sein würde in seiner Güte . . .] (EH "Destiny" 5, quoting Z II "On Human Prudence")

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The Complete Works of Friedrich Nietzsche

IN NINETEEN VOLUMES

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I

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Unfashionable Observations

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Based on Friedrich Nietzsche: Sämtliche Werke. Kritische Studienausgabe in 15

Bänden (1980), edited by Giorgio Colli and Mazzino Montinari. The Colli-

Montinari edition is of particular importance for the fragments and variants,

comprising more than half of Nietzsche's writings, many of which were

published there for the first time.

VOLUME 14

Unpublished Fragments

from the Period of Thus Spoke Zarathustra (Summer 1882-Winter 1883/84)

Translated, with an Afterword, by Paul S. Loeb and David E Tinsley

This volume provides the first English translation of Nietzsche's unpublished

notebooks from the period in which he was composing what he considered

his most important work, Thus Spoke Zarathustra. Crucial transitional documents

in Nietzsche's intellectual development, the notebooks mark a shift

into the philosopher's mature period. They reveal his long-term design of a

fictional tetralogy charting the journeys of his alter-ego, Zarathustra. Here, in

Thus Spoke Zarathustra's teaching about the death of God; his discovery that

the secret of life is the will to power; and his most profound and frightening

thought—that his own life, human history, and the entire

cosmos will eternally
return. During this same period, Nietzsche was also begin-
ning to make plans
for Beyond Good and Evil, and the notebooks provide insight
into his evolving
theory of drives, his ideas about morality, and his initial
thoughts on one of his
best-known concepts, the superhuman (Übermensch).
Paul S. Loeb is Professor Emeritus of Philosophy at the Uni-
versity of Puget Sound.
David E Tinsley is Professor Emeritus of German and Medieval
Studies at the
University of Puget Sound.
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Appendix B

Nachlass Volume 16: Unpublished Fragments (Spring 1885 – Spring 1886)

Translated by Adrian Del Caro

igea noes Unpublished Fragments (Spring 1885—Spring 1886) Translated, with an Afterword, by Adrian Del Caro [Page 1] Friedrich Nietzsche Unpublished Fragments (Spring 1885 Spring 1886) Translated, with an Afterword, by Adrian Del Caro STANFORD UNIVERSITY PRESS STANFORD, CALIFORNIA [Page 10] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 3 background a European condition in which the same horrible and filthy partisan activity we already find in France today also rules in Germany. 34[17] Has anyone ever conceded “profundity” to a female? So far I have not had respect for any female. D’Epinay compared with Galiani! And justice — has this ever — — — 34[8] The Italians genuine and original only in the bloody satire. From Buratti on, who provided the decisive turn to the genius of Byron. Even in Carducci there is nothing that Germans or French would not have done better. 34[9]’ I do not know myself: the demand for self-knowledge seems to me a divine joke or a Greek childishness (niaiserie®): they have a wealth of it! — But if someone has given his opinion on 500 things, then it is possible that others will “know” him. Well then! 34[10] Affectation of “scientism” e.g., “femininisme,”? but also g German periodicals’ “reviews-style.” 34[11] Our time consumes and lives on the morality of earlier times. 34[12] Pascal offended by the idea that the weather, that bright and cheerful skies influence him.!® Now — the theory of milieu’! is most convenient! everything exerts an influence, the result is the human being itself. [Page 100] 35 MAY-JULY 1885 93 indeed that, as far as there has been virtue in the world, it consisted in their kind of striving for their own happiness consequently also general happiness: none of all these ponderous, conscience-troubled herd animals — for that is what all of them are —wants to know anything of the fact that there is an order of rank of human beings, consequently that one morality for all is an impairment of the highest human being, that what is fair for one absolutely cannot be fair for another; that on the contrary the “happiness of greatest number” is a nauseating ideal for anyone (who) has the distinction of not belonging to the greatest number. — From France recently Comte’s superficial juxtaposition of altruism and egoism — but there is no altruism at all! — has made its way to England; and now we see e.g., in Herbert

Spencer the attempt to reconcile again with this too, but with such bad will toward taking any concept seriously anymore that henceforth in England even urinating would count among the altruistic activities. In Germany — where they do not even know what to do with the moral naïveté of Schopenhauer, E. von H(artmann) recently held forth on the Comtean idea — held forth to the tune of 871 pages” — ; and, without a single German bursting into laughter, solemnly and formally threw egoism out the door at the front, only to welcome it again in the name of “altruism” at the back. Indeed, there is no better way to visualize the uncanny fact of an almost sudden dumbing down of Europe’s peoples — visible in today’s Germany and England as well as in France and Italy — than by leafing through their moralistic books. At best I could highlight 3 small texts as exceptions (although even in these nothing fundamental is said): One is the book of a German Jew, Paul Rée, which bears the title? — On account of its form it deserves distinction and carries something of that genuine philosophical habitus to which Stendhal once gave a sharp formulation:?? — — — Rée adopts once more, with a subtle hand, the more rigorous habits of taste of the old French moralists — his book comes like a refreshing aroma from that “good old time,” far from all the edifying ulterior motives of which morality books written in German tend [Page 101] 94 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS to smell — : unfortunately he also has the same defects as those French, the narrow horizon, the wretchedness of knowledge; his hypotheses are cheap and a waste of breath; he completely lacks “the historical gaze and tact,” that is to say, the actual and single virtue that German science of the 19th century has over all older sciences. In the end it is a book that “stimulates the appetite.” Secondly I name the subtle, melancholy-robust book of a Frenchman? — — — , which, to be sure, like nearly everything that comes from Paris makes it all too plain where pessimism is really at home today: (namely not in Germany) And what good is all positivism and resolute kneeling before the “petits fait”?! In Paris they suffer as if from cold autumn winds, as if from a frost of great disappointments, as if winter were coming, the final, ultimate winter — and the best and the bravest, like that fine fellow Guyau, (tremble and shudder the while, even when they put on such a brave face with their “positivisme”?:? who believes that to which they want to persuade us with irony, that that trembling and shuddering even belong to the charms and seductive arts of life? To be sure: “shuddering is the finest portion of humanity”? — Goethe said that, and Goethe — was allowed to say it! But a Parisian? — Finally I single out the polemic book of a German half-Englishman, which contains enough spirit, acid and science to thoroughly “break down” that combination of bêtise*4 and Darwinism that Herbert Spencer put into the world under the title Data of Ethics: Rolph, Biologische Probleme 1881. To be sure, apart from the polemics there is nothing to praise in this book; and at bottom what offends us here, just as in the book that it contests, is the chiming-in

of insignificant people on areas where only a select kind of knower and “experienced one” speaks without immodesty.)^{35[35]}°7 What separates me most thoroughly from the metaphysicians is: I do not grant them that the “I” is what thinks: on the [Page 102] 35 MAY-JULY 1885 95 contrary I take the 7 itself as a construction of thinking, of the same rank as “material,” “thing,” “substance,” “individual,” “purpose,” “number”: therefore only as regulative fiction with whose help a kind of constancy, consequently “knowability” is posited into, fictionalized into a world of becoming. The belief in grammar, in the linguistic subject, object, in verbs has so far subjugated the metaphysicians: I taught that this belief should be abjured. The I is first posited by thinking: but up till now it was believed, as the people believe, that in “Z think” there existed something of direct certainty and this “I” was the given cause of thinking, by analogy with which we “understood” all remaining causal relations. However habitual and indispensable that fiction may be now, this offers no proof against its fictitiousness: something can be a condition of life and be false nevertheless. 35[36] Having freed myself from the tyranny of “eternal” concepts, I am on the other hand far from therefore plunging myself into an abyss of skeptical arbitrariness: on the contrary I ask that concepts be regarded as experiments with whose help certain kinds of humans {can be} cultivated and for their preservability and duration — — — 351371” The falseness of a concept is for me not yet an objection to it. Perhaps our new language sounds strangest in this respect: the question is, how far is it life-promoting, life-preserving, speciespreserving. I am even fundamentally of the belief that the falsest assumptions are precisely the most indispensable to us, that without an acceptance of logical fiction, without measuring reality against the invented world of the absolute, self-identical, human beings cannot live, and that a renunciation of this fiction, a practical dispensing with it, would amount to the same thing as a renunciation of life. To admit untruth as a condition of life: this truly means to rid oneself in a terrible way of the accustomed value emotions — and here, if anywhere, what matters is [Page 103] 96 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS not “bleeding to death” from the “known truth.” In this supreme danger one must immediately summon the creative basic instincts of humans, which are stronger than all value emotions: those which are the mothers of value emotions themselves and enjoy their sublime consolation in eternal birthing over the eternal perishing of their children. And finally: what power was it that forced us to abjure that “belief in truth,” if not life itself and all its creative basic instincts? — so that we therefore do not need to conjure up these “mothers”: — they are already up here, their eyes look at us, we simply execute that to which their magic has persuaded us.” 35[38]° — And as concerns act(ual) philos(ophy) in France today: no one should believe that these stout positivists that is to say empiricists from the school of Comte, or the successors of Stendhal Montesquieu

Condillac — heirs of the best that the 18th century had — like Taine, constitute a contrast to the skeptical mood of the century. 35139)" Noon and Eternity. I. On the Order of Rank. 2. The Legislators. (Cultivation of new ruling castes) 3. On the Ring of Rings. Or: "The Mirror." 4. The Great Blessings. 3slo]"? Noon and Eternity. Visions and Prophecies. 34" Noon and Eternity. Prophecies of a Man of the Future. [Page 104] 35 MAY-JULY 1885 97 Part One: On the Order of Rank. Part Two: On the Rulers of the Earth. Part Three: On the Ring of Rings. Part Four: On the New Dying. 35142]4 — until we, too, are capable of calling out with sufficient pride the words that Pericles called out to his Athenians in that funeral oration: to every land and sea our boldness has broken a path, everywhere founding timeless memorials for things good and wicked. 35143] In the end let us guard against the knowledge of human nature of these Sainte-Beuves and Renans, against this kind of sounding-out and sniffing-out of the soul as it is practiced by these unmanly and spineless hedonists of the spirit: it seems shameful to us when they fumble around with curious fingers on the secrets of humans or ages that were higher, stricter, deeper and in every respect nobler than they themselves: such that they would not have readily opened their doors to any such roaming half-women. But this nineteenth century, which has sacrificed all the finer instincts of order of rank, no longer knows how to rap the fingers of these unwanted interlopers and gate crashers; indeed, it is proud of its "historical sense," by virtue of which the sweating plebeian is allowed, providing he comes with scholarly instruments of torture and questionnaires, to penetrate even into the company of the supremely unapproachable, among the saints of conscience as well as among the eternally disguised rulers of [Page 105] 98 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS the spirit. More skepticism lies hidden beneath its historical sense and knowing than one sees at first: an insulting skepticism aimed at the difference in rank between human beings, and the same shameless demand for "equality" is even extended to include the dead, whom the paid servants of public opinion now presume to use against any of the living. But we are no skeptics — we still believe in an order of rank of human beings and problems and wait for the hour when this doctrine of rank and of order will onceagain inscribe itself plainly on the faces of this rabble-like society of today. Perhaps this hour is also our hour. Is it possible, if we are not skeptics, that we are critics or "criticists"? And if in our name we particularly underscored experiment and the joy in experimenting, does this perhaps occur because we love to avail ourselves of experiments in a broad and dangerous sense, but for the sake of a more deeply understood critique? Are we perhaps secretly, to the best of our knowledge, compelled to go further as experimenters than the soft-hearted and coddled taste of our century can condone? Indeed, we do not wish to forgo all those qualities that separate the critic from the skeptic: the certainty of value standard, the conscious application of a unity of method, cunning courage,

standing alone and being able to answer to oneself; indeed we confess to a joy in no-saying and dissecting, a certain cruelty of the hand that steadily wields the scalpel even if it is the heart that bleeds. We are harder — and perhaps not only toward ourselves — than “humane” people may wish; we do not get mixed up with “truth” because it “pleases” or “elevates” or “inspires” us — on the contrary our faith is small that truth could ever bring with it such pleasant feelings. It sounds awkward to many ears when we say: our suspicion is aroused precisely where our emotion rises up in beautiful surges; we smile if someone believes anything is proved by saying: “but this thought elevates me: how could it not be true?” Or: “this work delights me: how could it not be beautiful?” Or: “this artist enlarges me: how could he not be great?”TM On the contrary with critics we have — [Page 106] 35 MAY-JULY 1885 99 35144]*” Superstition about the philosopher, confusion with the scien(tific) person. As if values inhered in things and one only needed to determine them. To what extent they explore among given values (their hatred of appearance, body etc.) Schopenhauer with respect to morality. (Scorn for the utilitarian) In the end the confusion goes so far that Darwinism is regarded as philosophy: and now dominance is held by the scientific people. Even the French like Taine seek or think they seek without already having the value standards. Bowing down before the “facts,” a kind of cult. In fact they annihilate the existing valuations. Explanation of this misunderstanding. The commander emerges rarely, he misinterprets himself. One thoroughly wants to divert authority from oneself and posit it into circumstances. — In Germany appreciation for the critic belongs to the history of awakening manliness. Lessing etc. (Napoleon regarding Goethe) In fact this movement was cancelled out again by German romanticism: and the reputation of German philosophy hinges on it, as if the danger of skepticism were eliminated by it, and faith could be proven. Both tendencies culminate in Hegel: at bottom he generalized the fact of German criticism and the fact of German romanticism — a kind of dialectic fatalism, but in honor of the spirit, actually with the submission of the philosopher under reality. — The critic prepares the way: nothing more! With Schopenhauer the task of the philos(opher) dawns, that what is at stake is a determination of value: always still under the domination of eudaemonism (scorn for Hartmann) the ideal of pessimism. 35145] The philosopher as legislator, as attempter of new possibilities, his means. He uses religion. The New Testament — what Christianity can do. His opposite: the morality of the herd animal. Likewise the freethinkers etc. [Page 107] IOO UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS How the herd animals today imagine the “Superior Human”: to be demonstrated using V. Hugo. Those who prepared the way for me: Schopenhauer. the extent to which I deepened pessimism and first made it entirely palpable to myself by inventing its highest opposite. Then: the ideal artists, those offspring from the Napoleonic movement. Then: the higher

Europeans, forerunners of the great politics. Then: the Greeks and their emergence. I gave hints in the Birth of Tragedy about the relationship between “necessity” and “art.” The Germans and the spirit. The personal education of the philosopher: solitude. The Dionysian. 35146] Paete, non dolet!®? Paete, this pessimism does not hurt! Paete, Eduard does not bite! Paete, look at me: am I not friendly blue, yes even Prussian blue; Paete, indeed, I leave nothing at all to be desired Paete, non dolet! Paete, this pessimism does not hurt! Paete, your Arria does not bite! Paete: Eduard is full of knowledge, cozy, humane, friendly, even friendly to the empire, even Prussian blue, in sum Eduard is a girl Friday and his pessimism leaves nothing at all to be desired I was in error back then: I thought E(duard) vlon} H(artmann) was a subtle superior mind and joker who was making fun of the pessimistic embarrassment of the age; I found the invention of his “unconscious” so malicious, so witty, it seemed to me a real mousetrap for the doleful and dumb of philosophical dilettantism as it spreads more and more across Germany. But now they insist on assuring me that he means it seriously: and they are practically forcing me to believe in it: but is it [Page 108] 35 MAY-JULY 1885 IOI supposed to stop being entertaining for me? Am I supposed to have to stop laughing when this Arria again and again tries to encourage her Paetus not to be afraid of the dagger, I mean of Hartmannian pessimism? Paete, she calls tenderly, non dolet! 35147] § No critics. Embarrassment. Finally “the scientific human being.” The English. § Neither pessimists nor optimists. Schopenhauer’s great position — that the destruction of an illusion still does not yield truth, but one more piece of ignorance, an expansion of our “empty space,” a growth of our inner “desolation” —*° § Basic thought: the new values must first be created — we are not spared this! The philosopher must be like a legislator. New types. (How the highest types (e.g., the Greeks) were cultivated so far: to consciously will this kind of “chance”)?! § His means: Religions, moralities § Meaning of Christianity. § Meaning of the democratic way of thinking. § Freethinkers, included in this movement? Victor Hugo. § Unconscious counter-movements: Napoleon, the 30s, R(ichard) W(agner). § The new philosopher can only emerge in connection with a ruling caste, as their highest spiritualization. Great politics, rule of the earth are near; complete lack of principles for this? — (irony toward the empty German spirit) § The European and his education. § Period of grand experiments. Humans with their own canon of values. Institutions for the cultivation of superior humans. § The “for the time being” of philosophers. Their solitude. § Prepare the “Beyond Good and Evil.” State of “morality.” 15 § Dionysus. 15: 110 | 6 3 big pages for each section [Page 109] 102 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 35148] Preface. It matters little to me today whether I was right or wrong with respect to R(ichard) W(agner) and Schopenhauer: if I erred, well, my error accrues to the dishonor neither of those mentioned nor myself. What is certain is that in those early days it was a

tremendous boon to me to be able to paint my idealist colors, in which I viewed the images (of the) philosopher and (the) artist, not entirely upon the unreal but as it were upon previously sketched figures; and if I was accused of having looked at the aforementioned with a magnifying eye, then I am glad to be so accused — and glad, too, for my eyes. At least the reader of the second Unfashionable Observation should not be in doubt as to how little I was always concerned about the truth and — — — What I wrote at that time — and wrote less than painted, and on top of that heatedly and, as it seems to me today, in a daring and not unobjectionable *alfresco*: this would not become more true if I portrayed it again more gently, colorfully and rigorously now that my hand and eye have perhaps learned something in the meantime. Each period of life understands “truth” in its own way; and whoever steps up to that painting with youthful and stormy senses and great demands will find as much truth in it as he is capable of seeing. My first four U(nfashionable) O(bservations), to which I now add a fifth, sixth and seventh after ten years, were attempts to lure to myself the kind of humans who belong to me: thus fishhooks cast to hook “my kind.” Back then I was young enough to go fishing in such a way with impatient hope. Today — after a hundred years if I may measure time according to my standard! — I am still not old enough to have lost all hope, all patience. How strange it sounds to my ears even today when an old man compresses his experience into these words: — — — Thus speaks Goethe: could he be right? Then how unreasonable it would be to grow as old a(nd) as reasonable as Goethe! [Page 11]

4 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 34[13] Things which my stomach digests poorly or not at all: potatoes, ham, mustard, onions, pepper, anything baked in fat, puff pastry, cauliflower, cabbage, lettuce, all oily vegetables, wine, sausage, butter sauce on meat, chives, fresh breadcrumb, all sourdough bread. Anything roasted, any meat served rare, veal, roast beef, leg of lamb, egg yolk a(nd) milk also whipped cream, rice, semolina, cooked warm apples green peas beans carrots roots fish, fresh butter brown white bread crust. 34[14] The kind of open and hearty familiarity that is needed today in a democratic age in order to be beloved and respected — in sum that for which someone today is treated as an “upright human being”: this gives a moralist much to laugh about. All profound people enjoy their kind of relief here; it is such a pleasure to play at comedy and — — — 34[1]”? The ancients read aloud. 34[16] Among immoderate people, e.g., English rabble, naturally the doctrine of abstinence acquires tremendous power. Among the moderate it is a laughable matter. 34[17] Dionysian. What unfortunate shyness to speak as a scholar on a subject of which I should have been able to speak as an “experienced one.” And what does someone who has to write poetry care about “aesthetics”? One should practice one’s trade, and send curiosity to the devil! 34[118]? The XXth Century. Abbé Galiani once said — — — now since I do not in the least share the unwarlike views of my

departed friend Galiani, [Page 110] 35 MAY-JULY 1885 103 And it would be fair like the Greeks to heed their judgment concerning old age: — they hated growing old more than death, and loved to die when they felt themselves becoming reasonable in that manner. Meanwhile youth, too, has its own kind of reason: a reason that believes in life, love and hope 35[49]°4 As concerns R(ichard) W(agner): there was a moment in my life when I vehemently pushed him away from me. Away from me! — is what I cried. This kind of artist is untrustworthy precisely where I tolerate no joking. He tried to come to an “arrangement” with existing Christianity by extending his left hand to Protestant communion — he spoke to me of the delights he was able to experience from this communion — but at the same time his right hand to the Catholic Church: he offered it his Parsifal and let himself be known as a “creature of Rome” in partibus in fidelium” by all who had ears. 35150] The laws of thinking as results of organic development — a fake positing force must be assumed — likewise inheritance and continuation of the fictions. 3s1s] In a world of becoming in which everything is conditioned, the acceptance of the unconditional, of substance, of being, of a thing etc. can only be an error. But how is error possible? 3s[52] To show succession ever more clearly means explanation: nothing more! 35153] To concede perception even for the inorganic world and moreover with absolute accuracy: there “truth” reigns! With the organic world begin indefiniteness and illusion. [Page 111] 104 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 35[54]°° That a state of equilibrium is never achieved proves that it is not possible. But in an indefinite space it must have been achieved. Likewise in a spherical space. The shape of space must be the cause of eternal motion and ultimately of all “imperfection.” That “force” and “inertia” “remaining self-identical” are in conflict with one another. The extent of force as magnitude as fixed, but its essence fluid, tense, compelling, — — — 3s1ss}°° “Timeless” to be refuted. In a specific moment of force the absolute conditionality of a new distribution of all its forces is given: it cannot stand still. “Change” belongs to its essence, therefore also temporality: but by this only the necessity of change is once again conceptually posited. 351]°° Time is not a priori given. Spir 2, p. 7. illogical character of our knowledge of bodies, cf. 2 p. 93. 35157]? That there are identical things, identical cases, is the basic fiction already when making a judgment, then when making an inference. 35158] In the chemical world reigns the sharpest perception of difference in force. But a protoplasm, as a multiplicity of chemical forces, has an uncertain and indefinite overall-perception of a foreign object. 351] The transition from the world of the inorganic into that of the organic is that from the firmest perceptions of force values and power ratios into that of uncertain, indefinite ones. because [Page 112] 35 MAY-JULY 1885 105 a multiplicity of warring beings (= protoplasm) feels itself in opposition to the external world. 35[60] The restless will to power or to constant creation or to

transformation or to self-overpowering 35[61]°° “so-called time a mere abstraction, neither existing objectively nor a necessary and original representational mode of the subject” (Spir) 2, p. 15. 35[62] The Germans have no culture: they are dependent on Paris now as before — the cause is they still have no character. Our great human beings do not constitute a race, but individuals. But what is it that I formerly set aside and on which I founded my hopes, German music? 35163] NB. Misunderstanding about Richard Wagner is enormous in Germany today: a(nd) since I have contributed to increasing it, I want to pay my debt and attempt to decrease it 35164] NB. For two centuries there was only one contrast between French and Ital{ian) music. In the struggle between Gluck and Piccini it sharpened and came to a head: here Gluck was perceived entirely as a representative of French taste — as a representative of the noble, pompous and rationalistic. The Germans as musicians listened in turn in the direction of France and Italy: even today the Germans do not yet have their own taste in music [Page 113] 106 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS It seems to me that Wagner once again brought French taste to predominance over Italian, i.e., over Mozart, Haydn, Rossini, Bellini, Mendelssohn, but it is the taste of 1830s France: literature become dominant over music as over painting. “Program-music,” with the “sujet” in the forefront! 35165] Beethoven belongs to Rousseau and to the humanitarian current which partly anticipated the Revolution, partly succeeded it transfiguratively, but even more he belongs to the main event of the last century, the appearance of Napoleon. Mozart presupposing the society of the Rococo age 35166] Difference between actors, like Schiller and Wagner and Goethe isolated, between Pietism and Hellenism, doubtful whether he should not write in French. Lessing — Bayle Frederick the Great keen on France Frederick II on Moorish-Eastern enlightenment Leibniz between Christianity Platonism and mechanics. Bismarck learning from Napoleon III and Cavour 35167] If mechanics is only a logic, then what follows for it is also what applies for all logic: it is a kind of spine for vertebrates, nothing true-in-itself. 35[68] On the Ring of Rings. NB. An inside belongs to the power that transforms and always remains the same, a kind of character of Proteus-Dionysus, disguising itself and enjoying itself in transformation. To comprehend the [Page 114] 35 MAY-JULY 1885 107 “person” as deception: in fact heredity is the main objection, insofar as innumerable formative forces from much earlier times assert their constant existence: in truth they struggle in it and are ruled and tamed — a will to power cuts through persons, it requires the diminution of perspective, “egoism,” as an occasional condition of existence; on every step it looks out for an even higher one. The diminution of the effective principle to a “person,” to the individual. 35169] NB. How much someone bears of the truth, without degenerating, is his standard. Likewise how much happiness — — likewise how much freedom and power! On the order of rank 35[70] The most rigorous school

needed, misfortune, illness: there would be no spirit on earth, also no delight and jubilation. — Only great-spirited, tense souls know what art, what cheerfulness are. 3s(71@ Zarathustra) can only succeed when he has first established the order of rank. 3572] NB. There must be many superhumans: all goodness develops only among its kind. One god would always be a devil! A ruling race. On “the rulers of the earth.” I. Zarathustra can only succeed after the order of rank has been established. At first this will be taught. II. The order of rank executed in a system of earthly rule: the rulers of the earth last, a new ruling caste. Springing up from them here and there, quite Epicurean god, the superhuman, the transfigurer of existence. [Page 115] 108 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS III. The superhuman interpretation of the world. Dionysus. IV. Lovingly returning to the closest and smallest things 35174. from this greatest alienation, Zarathustra blessing all his experiences and dying as a blesser. J Zarathustra) 5. I. g CON AM Great trumpet-herald’s noise. Happiness of loud notes! Zarathustra I. I am that predestined human who determines values for thousands of years. A hidden one, one forced to go everywhere, a human without friends who has rejected every homeland, every rest. What makes the grand style. Becoming master over one’s happiness as well as one’s unhappiness: a — — — My gift will only be received when there are receivers: for this order of rank. The greatest events are the latest to be comprehended. — To this extent I must be a legislator. . The time of its appearance: the most dangerous middle, where it can go over to “last human,” but also — — characterized by the greatest event: God is dead. Only humans do not yet notice anything of the fact that they are living only on inherited values. The general negligence and squandering. . — Basic insight: “good” and “evil” are now observed as from the eye of the “herd animal.” Equality of humans as goal. Against this me: (The One God as preparation for herd morality!) the teacher of the order of rank. . Leaders, herds and isolated ones. The tempters. . Complete humans and fragments. . Those who turned out well and turned out badly. . Creators and those who were shaped. Difference in strength. . Artists and small completers. [Page 116] 35 MAY-JULY 1885 109 to. the scientific people as describers and most comprehensive organs. u. the lordly people, as attempts at cultivation. 12. the religion founders; as attempts at new universal value positing. 133. the feeling of imperfection: the penitents 14. The strain in the direction of perfection: the pious, the beautiful souls, the great longings 1s. The force to do the perfect somehow (master-artisans artists officials scholars etc. 16. the earth now lying there as a marble workshop: a ruling race is needed, with absolute power. 351751% 1. Zarathustra awakening on the old fortress. Hears the drumming of the heralds. 2. The test. “Do you belong to me?” 3. The rose festival parade. 4. The doctrine of the order of rank. 5. Nighttime on the bridge. 35176] °8 (49) What is noble? Preface to “Mixed Opinions and Maxims” — meticulousness in the most external things, even the fr(ivolous)

ap(pearance), in word, clothing, demeanor, insofar as this meticulousness sets apart, keeps at a distance, protects from being confused for someone else. — the slow gesture, also the slow gaze. There are not too many valuable things: and these automatically come to and want to go to the valuable ones. We have a hard time admiring. — the bearing of poverty and of neediness, also of illness. — the avoidance of small honors, and suspicion of everyone who easily praises: for the praiser believes that he understands [Page 117] IIO UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS what he praises: but to understand — Balzac revealed it, this typical ambitious one — *comprendre c'est éгалer*.^o — Our doubt about the communicability of the heart goes deep; solitude, not as chosen but as given, — the conviction that one has responsibilities only to one's kind, behaves toward others as he pleases: that only *inter pares*? can justice be hoped for (unfortunately not counted on in the least). — irony toward the “talented”; belief in nobility of birth even in moral matters. “Aristocrats of the spirit” — is a euphemism for Jews. — to always feel oneself as someone who has to forgive honors: whereas it is not very often that someone is found who is allowed to honor him. — always disguised: the higher the type, the more a human needs the incognito. God, if there were one, should be permitted, for purposes of decency, to reveal himself in the world only as a human. — the capacity for *otium*,” the absolute conviction that a trade in any sense does not disgrace one, to be sure, but certainly disennobles. Not “industriousness” in the bourgeois sense, as highly as we esteem it, or like those insatiably cackling artists who do as the hens — cackle and lay eggs and cackle some more. — we protect the artists and poets and whoever is a master in anything: but as beings who are of a superior kind than these who are only skilled at something, than the merely “productive people,” do not confuse us with them. — enjoyment of forms; the taking-under-protection of everything related to form, the conviction that courtesy is one of the great virtues; suspicion of all kinds of letting-oneself-go including all freedom of the press and thought, because under them the spirit becomes comfortable and oafish and relaxes. — pleasure in women, as in a perhaps smaller, but subtler and lighter kind of being. What happiness to encounter beings who always have dance and folly and finery on their minds! They have been the delight of all very tense and profound manly souls, whose lives are burdened with great responsibilities. [Page 118] 35 MAY-JULY 1885 III — pleasure in princes and priests, because even in the assessment of the past at least symbolically and on the whole even literally they uphold the belief in a difference of human values, in sum in the order of rank. — the ability to keep silent: but not a word of this before listeners. — bearing of long hostilities: the lack of easy reconciliation. — disgust with demagoguery, with the “Enlightenment,” with “coziness,” with rabble-like intimacy. — the collecting of precious things, the needs of a higher and more selective soul; wanting to have nothing in common. His books, his

landscapes. — we revolt against bad and good experiences and do not so quickly generalize. The individual case: how ironic we are toward the individual case when it has the bad taste to behave like a rule. — we love what is naive and the naive, but as observers and higher beings, we find Faust to be just as naive as his Gretchen. — we have a lowly estimation of the good, as herd animals: and know how among the worst most malicious harshest human beings often an inestimable gold drop of goodness keeps itself hidden, which all mere kindness and milky soul — — — — we do not consider a human of our kind refuted either by his vices, nor by his follies. We know that we are hard to recognize, and that we all have grounds to give ourselves foregrounds. 35177] Letters of Count — — — Edited by J. v. A. After the death of my mother. Invent anecdotes. [Page 119] 112 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 35[78]]? Preface. Is one permitted to publish letters? — A venerable friend of mine was accustomed to pronouncing the word “public” never without malice. The nineteenth century, he once said, loves truth, as everyone knows: well, with precisely this taste it offends my taste! I fear that if this continues, people will write only public letters from now on. Yes, he said on another occasion, it could come to pass that at some time a decent human being would summarize his entire morality in a single sentence: thou shalt — lie! Sir, you shall absolutely and always lie! Or you, too, are what everyone else already is — “public”! This was his secret opinion of the taste of our century. As I contemplated giving a title to his collection of letters and opinions, it crossed my mind to characterize them thus: “The Mirror. An Opportunity for Self-Reflection. For Europeans.” May one glean from this tasteless idea of mine at least how much value Z personally ascribe to these letters — and why I give myself the right to publish these letters precisely out of hatred for everything that is called “public” today. 35179] Century of minstrels (t(he) p(eople) of the dishonest burial) (Galiani) murderers boredom. 35180] The Germans of Yesterday and of the Day After Tomorrow A Contribution to the Critique of the German Soul 35[81] The demagogues in art. — Hugo Michelet Sand R. Wagner 35182] A pessimistic way of thinking and doctrine an ecstatic nihilism can be indispensable to precisely the philosopher under certain [Page 12] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 5 I am not afraid to prophesy a few things and therefore, possibly, bring about the cause of wars. 4 34!] A tremendous coming to one’s senses after the most terrible earthquake: with new questions. 34[20] NB. The centuries just prior to the last rejected the Gothic as barbarism (the Goth back then was synonymous with the barbarian): the next to last century rejected Homer. Therein lies a taste: a strong will to one’s Yes and one’s No. — The capacity to enjoy Homer again is perhaps the greatest achievement of European people — but it has been paid for dearly enough. 34[21] Baudelaire, already entirely German, except for a certain hyper-erotic ailment that smells of Paris 34[22]]° Taine, who had the boldness of invention to find the typical between

Hegel and Henri Beyle,¹⁰ his method, which essentially means: history can be comprehended only through concepts; but the concepts must be created by the historical human being: and the history in which there are only 4, 5 factors is the most comprehensible. 34[23]” the masquerade of the bourgeois, e.g., as Salambé and as Saint Anthony 34[24] Some who are at bottom shallow and light beings — peoples as well as individuals — have their most estimable and supreme moments when all of a sudden, to their astonishment, they become heavy and melancholy. In the same way, perhaps for the [Page 120] 35 MAY-JULY 1885 113 circumstances: as a powerful pressure and hammer, with which he smashes races that are degenerating and dying out and clears them out of the way, (in order) to pave the way for a new order of life or in order to impart a longing for the end to what is degenerate and wants to die out.” For the delaying and deepening of peoples and races a pessimistic way of thinking, a religion of negation and escape from the world, an ecstatic desensualization and uglification of life can — — — 35183] But, insofar as I have these kinds of worries and prepare a long answer to such a question — oh, maybe I myself am nothing more than a long answer to this question? — I already hear that broken and malicious voice 35[84]”^o Gai Saber. Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future. By Friedrich Nietzsche. To the Mistral.” Introduction. Book One: The Prejudices of the Philosophers. Book Two: Beyond Good and Evil. Book Three: To the Artists. Book Four: The Mirror. An Opportunity for Self-Reflection for Europeans. Book Five: The Noble Soul. Among Friends: An Aftersong.”[®] the ideal cloister, for the preservation of delicate plants the future of music — Europeans’ music music of grand style the snares of language Wagnermania and Hegelmania as intoxicants “classic” — inapplicable word in music [Page 121] II UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS the hermits, like Goethe, Beethoven, and the demagogic or courtly or ecclesiastical artists. education of musicians. against the “nationalistic” ambitions in art concept of culture; — style etc. rejection of pessimisme, likewise of all eudaemonistic points of view. III To the Artists. New concept of the creator; the Dionysian. New festivals. The transfiguration. “Perfected Infinity” pain and joy purpose value judgments in perceptions of taste, colors, sounds establish concepts the re-interpretability of the world — but holding on to the basic features what is pathological about philosophers cause and effect the economy of affects the “persona” Luther’s discourse, the Bible as the foundation of a new poetic form. [Page 122] [36 = W I 4. June-July 1885] 36h] Gai Saber. Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future. By Friedrich Nietzsche. Appendix The Modern Soul. Attempt at an Elucidation concerning Today and Tomorrow. 36[2] Never has more been demanded of living creatures than with the emergence of terra firma: accustomed to and equipped for life in the sea, now they had to turn around and overturn their body and their customs and act differently in all things than they had been accustomed up till then — so far there has been no more

remarkable transformation on earth. —Just as back then the sea descended into the faults caves pits and acquired depth through cave-ins, through a slow breaking down of the earth: so, too, what now transpires among human beings perhaps offers the precise opposite, to speak metaphorically: namely humans are becoming whole and rounded, the faults caves and pits are disappearing and consequently also — terra firma is disappearing. For a human made rounded and whole by my way of thinking, “everything is in the sea,” the sea is everywhere: but the sea itself has lost its depths. — Yet I was on my way to a quite [Page 123] 116 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS different metaphor and only got lost! I wanted to say: like everyone I was born a land animal — and now nevertheless I must be a sea animal! 3603] Germany, which is wealthy in talented and highly educated scholars, for a long time has lacked great souls, powerful spirits to such an extent that it appears to have forgotten what a great soul, what a powerful spirit is: and nowadays human beings who are mediocre and turned out badly take themselves to market, almost in good conscience and devoid of all embarrassment, and praise themselves as great men, reformers; as does for example Eugen Dühring, a talented and well-educated scholar, but who reveals with almost every word that he harbors a petty soul and is crushed by narrow jealous feelings; also that he is not driven by a powerful, brimming, benevolently squandering spirit — but by ambition! But to thirst for honors in this age is far unworthier of a philosopher than in any earlier age: today where the rabble rules, where the rabble bestows the honors! 36[4] When the philosopher joins the *homines bonae voluntatis*,’ the good-natured, compassionate, gentle, everyday people, then it is as if he landed in humid air and beneath a cloudy sky: for a short time it does him good, he feels relieved, as it were; but if he pays close attention, he notices how he himself is becoming comfortable and negligent in this false environment; vain too — but above all melancholy. In order to quickly learn how weak and meager is the constitution of this good-natured human material, with all their obliging appearance, he might irritate and wound their vanity, let him get them to the point where they become abusive: then the “undeeppness” of these waters will betray itself soonest, and also surely what kind of sand and filth or presumptuousness lies hidden beneath all this well-mannered light azure surface. [Page 124] 36 JUNE-JULY 1885 117 36[5] The women in Europe, quite aside from their real business (“laying children”) are useful for many good things. It is pleasant to dance with Viennese women. With a French woman one can causer, with an Italian poser, with a German — oser.! Among Jewish women are the best prattlers of all: the model for this, all wrapped up in Goethean lace and smugness, was Rahel’ A Russian woman has usually experienced something, occasionally thought something. English women know how to blush in the most feminine and heavenly manner, almost without a reason, like the angels; in sum, we would never finish if we once tried to stiffly

and steadfastly prove the usefulness of woman — something that everyone believes in — using the m(odel) of E(nglish) u(tilitarians). 36[6]° Gai saber. Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future. To the Mistral. A Dance Song. Part I. 1. “Without a passionate pleasure Conclusion. “And do you know what ‘the world’ is to me? Part II. Conclusion. “When I was very young, Dionysus. Part III. On the Future of the Arts. Part IV. The Mirror. Part V. Among Free Spirits. 36[7]’ My “compassion.” — This is a feeling for which no name suffices for me: I sense it where I see a waste of precious capabilities, for example at the sight of Luther: what strength, and what tasteless back woods-problems (at a time when in France [Page 125] 118 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS the courageous and cheerful skepticism of a Montaigne was already possible!) Or where I see someone fall short of what he could have become, due to the influence of a stupidity of chance. Or even when thinking of the fate of humankind, as when I watch, with fear and contempt, the European politics of today which under all circumstances is also working on the fabric of the future of all human beings. Indeed, what could become of “humans” if — — ! This is a kind of “compassion”; even if there is no suffering one with whom I might suffer here.’ 36 [8]? Moralia? Just as from time immemorial humans have lived in profound unfamiliarity with their bodies and allow a few formulations to suffice for communicating about their well-being, so too is the case with our judgments on the value of humans and deeds: privately we cling to a few external and incidental symbols and have no feeling for how deeply unfamiliar and foreign we are to ourselves. And as concerns judgment about others: how quick and “certain” even the most cautious and the fairest are to judge! 36[9]” Moralia. Sparse reflection is required to expose the fact that there is no “good in itself” — that something good must be thought only as “good for what,” and that what is good in one purpose necessarily will at the same time be “evil and harmful” in many other purposes: in sum that each thing to which we . [<4 Do. . . . (3 1» apply the predicate “good” is likewise characterized as “evil for precisely that reason. 36[10]!? How long has it been that I have made an effort to prove the complete innocence of becoming in myself !? And what strange paths I have already walked in doing so! Once the right solution [Page 126] 36 JUNE-JULY 1885 119 seemed to me that I decreed: “existence, as something resembling a work of art, is not at all under the jurisdictio” of morality; on the contrary morality itself belongs in the realm of appearance.” Another time I said: all guilt-concepts are objectively completely worthless, but subjectively all life is necessarily unjust and alogical. A third time I extracted from myself the denial of all purposes and perceived the unknowability of causal combinations. And why did I do all this? Was it not to provide myself with the feeling of complete irresponsibility — to position myself outside of any praise and blame, independent of all formerly and today, in order to pursue my goal in my way? — 36[11] At bottom morality is hostile toward

science: already Socrates was this — and moreover because science takes things as important that have nothing to do with “good” and “evil,” and consequently take importance away from the feeling for “good” and “evil.” For morality wants the whole human being and his entire strength to be at its service: it regards it as a squandering of someone who is not rich enough to squander when a human seriously concerns himself with plants and stars. This is why in Greece things rapidly went downhill with scientism when Socrates dragged the illness of moralizing into science; a height such as that in the mentality of a Democritus, Hippocrates and Thucydides was not achieved for a second time. 36[12]!6

Human Being in Relations with Others It is a sign of a lack of noble-mindedness when someone on the street responds to a greeting before he has recognized the person who greeted: — greeting and kind of greeting should be distinctions, after all — with the sole exception that a prince (or he qui range aux souverains!) goes his way and is greeted. It is his prerogative not to have to know anyone, but to have to be known by all. A parable. [Page 127] 120 UNPUBLISHED

FRAGMENTS 36[13]!8 The H(uman Being) By Oneself Alone: How differently one perceives the business and the work of his life if he is the first in his family to do it or when the father and grandfather have already been active in the same way! In the former case, where one is the first, one has much more inner distress from it, also a much more sudden pride; good conscience is not yet wedded to such an activity, and something about it will readily be felt as arbitrary, as incidental. 36[14]” What value Wagner might have for the non-musician, and might also retain going forward, the question should be spared us for now. Without any doubt Richard Wagner gave the Germans of this age the most comprehensive notion of what an artist could be: — respect for “the artist” suddenly shot up: everywhere he awakened new valuations, new desires, new hopes; and perhaps not least through the merely heralding, incomplete, imperfect nature of his artistic creations. Who did not learn from him! And even if not so directly, like the artists of elocution and the poser-humans”° of every kind, then certainly at least indirectly, “occasioned by Richard Wagner,” as one may be allowed to say. Even philosophical knowledge gained no meager impulse from his appearance, of this there is no doubt. Today there is an abundance of aesthetic problems of which even the subtlest minds had no whiff before Richard Wagner — above all the problem of the actor and his relation) to the different arts, not to mention psychological problems as they are copiously provided by Wagner’s character and W(agnerian) art. To be sure: insofar as he himself ventured into the realm of knowledge he deserves no praise, on the contrary an unconditional rejection; in the gardens of science he always distinguished himself only as the most immodest and untalented intruder. The “philosophizing” of Wagner belongs to the most illicit kinds of dilettantism; that people did not even know enough to laugh at it is German and belongs to the old German “cult of obscurity.” But if

one [Page 128] 36 JUNE-JULY 1885 II absolutely wants to assist him in the acquisition of honors and statues even as a “thinker” — the good will and the subservience of his disciples will not be able to forgo this — so be it! then I recommend he be depicted as the genius of German obscurity itself, with a smoking torch in hand, inspired and in the act of stumbling over a stone. When Wagner “thinks,” he stumbles. — But we will be concerned with Wagner the musician). 36[15]” If the world had a goal then it must have been reached. If an unintended final state existed for it, then it likewise must have been reached. If it were generally capable of stopping and becoming fixed, of “being,” if it had this capacity for “being” for only a single moment in all its becoming, then in turn all its becoming would have ended long ago, therefore also all thinking, all “spirit.” The fact of a “spirit” as a form of becoming proves that the world has no goal, no final state and is incapable of being. — But the old habit of thinking of goals with every event that happens and of a guiding creative God with the world is so powerful that a thinker has trouble in not thinking to himself that even the aimlessness of the world is a purpose. This notion — namely that the world deliberately avoids a goal and even knows how to artificially guard against getting caught in an orbit — must occur to all who wish to decree upon the world the capacity for eternal novelty, that is for a finite, specific, unchangeable force of constant size as is “the world” — the miracle-capacity for infinite restructuring of its forms and states. The world, even if no longer a god, is still supposed to be capable of divine creative force, of infinite transformational force; it is supposed to willfully resist falling back into one of its old forms, it is supposed to have not only the intention but also the means to protect itself from every repetition, thus in every moment it is supposed to control each of its movements with respect to avoiding goals, final states, repetitions — and whatever else may be the consequences of such an unforgivably insane manner of thinking and desiring. That is still the old religious way of thinking and [Page 129] 122 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS desiring, a kind of longing to believe that in some way the world is indeed the same as the old beloved, infinite, boundlessly creative God — that in some way “the old God still lives” after all — that longing of Spinoza’s which expresses itself in the phrase “deus sive natura” (he even felt “natura sive deus” —). But what then is the proposition and belief with which the decisive turn, the now attained upper hand of the scientific spirit over the religious god-creating spirit is most distinctly formulated? Is it not: the world, as force, must not be thought as unlimited, for it cannot be thought thus — we forbid ourselves the concept of an infinite force as incompatible with the concept “force.” Therefore — the world also lacks the capacity for eternal novelty. 36 [16] If I could have my way: then it is time to declare war on European morality, and likewise on everything that has sprouted from it. This temporary order of the peoples and states of Europe must be

smashed. The Christian-democratic way of thinking favors the herd-animal, the diminution of human beings, it weakens the great motivating forces (evil —), it hates compulsion, harsh discipline, great responsibilities, great risks. The mediocre win the day and assert their value standards. 36[17] But to whom do I say this? Where then are these “free spirits”? Is there even such a thing as “between ourselves”? — I look around me: who thinks, who feels as I do about this? Who wants what my most concealed will wants? But so far I found no one. Perhaps I only searched badly? Perhaps those who suffer from my kind of new plight and new happiness must conceal themselves in the same way that I do — ? And don masks as I did? — And consequently are not much good at seeking their kind? We new philosophers, we tempters, think otherwise — and we do not want to leave it at thinking. We think more freely — perhaps the day will come when people see with their own [Page 13] 6 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS cattle-rabble that formerly started grunting morally in English Puritanism or today as English Salvation Army — the penitential spasm is their highest achievement of “humanity”; we should simply acknowledge this. — But others become superior when they become lighter! There is no doubt: when a kind of human being has lived out entire generations as teachers physicians pastors and models, and without constantly looking out for money or honor or positions: then ultimately a higher and subtler and more spiritual type arises. In this manner the priest, providing that he reproduces through strong women, is a kind of preparation for the future emergence of superior human beings. 34[25] Such dogmatic people as Dante and Plato are the most distant and perhaps for that reason the most alluring: who live in a house of knowledge that is carpentered and held together by faith. The first in his own, the other in the Christian-patristic. There is an entirely different strength and mobility to maintaining oneself in an incomplete system, with free, open vistas, than in a dogmatic world. Leonardo da Vinci stands higher than Michelangelo, Michelangelo higher than Raphael. 34[26] Praised among the educated of today (who all pro pudor!® read newspapers) are the profound people. But what do those who are in a position to praise profound people know about profundity themselves! — They are dangerous people: of this there is no doubt at all. We otherwise do not tend to praise the abysses! 34[27]”° Letters To a Philosophical Friend. On the Occasion of Thus Spoke Zarathustra. By Friedrich Nietzsche. [Page 130] 36 JUNE-JULY 1885 123 eyes that we also act more freely. Meanwhile we are difficult to recognize; people have to mistake us. Are we “freethinkers”? In all European countries and likewise in North America there are now “freethinkers”: do they belong with us? No, gentlemen, you want almost the opposite of that which lies in the intentions of those philosophers whom I call tempters; they sense little temptation to trade mendacious pleasantries with you. Indeed, if you “freethinkers” had only a whiff of what one can free himself from, and where one is then driven! I believe you

would be among the most raging opponents of that which I call my “freedom of spirit and my “Beyond Good and Evil.” That I no longer need to believe in “souls,” that I deny “personality” and its alleged unity and in each human being find the material for very different “personae” (and masks), that to me “absolute spirit” and “pure knowing” signify mythical creatures behind which a *contradictio in adjecto*? clumsily conceals itself — with this I am perhaps on the same path as many of those “freethinkers,” not to mention at all the denial of God, with which even today a few self-satisfied Englishmen assume they are providing a tremendous sample of free-mindedness. What separates me from them are valuations: for they all belong to the democratic movement and want equal rights for all, they see in the forms of our previous old society the causes for human deficiencies and degenerations, they enthuse about smashing these forms: and sometimes they imagine the most humane thing they could do is to help all human beings to reach their degree of spiritual “freedom.” Briefly and plainly, they belong to the “/evelers” — to that kind of human being who crudely offends my taste in every way, and offends my reason even more: I want war and opposites even in matters of the spirit; and more war than ever, more o(pposites) than ever; I would sooner condone the harshest despotism (as a school for the flexibility of the spirit) than the humid tepid air of an age of “freedom of the press,” in which all spirit becomes comfortable and stupid and stretches its limbs. In this matter I am still today what I was — “untimely.” [Page 131] 124

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS But we new philosophers: we are not only beginning with the portrayal of factual order of rank and value differences in humans, but we also want precisely the opposite of an assimilation, an equalization: we teach estrangement in every sense of the word, we tear open chasms as they have never existed before, we want humans to be more evil than they ever were. For the time being we ourselves still live as strangers to one another and concealed. It will be necessary for us for many reasons to be hermits and even to don masks — consequently we will be in a poor position to seek our kind. We will live alone and probably know the agonies of all seven solitudes. But if we do cross one another’s path, by accident, then you can bet that we will fail to recognize one another or mutually deceive ourselves.”⁴ 36[18]”° I am wary of speaking of chemical “laws”: this has a moral aftertaste. On the contrary what is at stake is an absolute determination of power relationships: the stronger gains mastery over the weaker, at least as far as the latter cannot assert its degree of independence — here there is no mercy, no sparing, even less a respect for “laws”! 36[19]°° It is improbable that our “knowledge” should reach further than is just required for the preservation of life. Morphology shows us how the senses and nerves, as well as the brain develop in proportion to the difficulty of finding nourishment. 36[20]”° Even in the realm of the inorganic, for an atom of force only its own neighborhood comes into consideration: the forces in the distance

even themselves out. Herein lies the kernel of the perspectival, and why a living being is “egoistic” through and through. [Page 132] 36 JUNE-JULY 1885 125 36[21]28 The weaker presses itself upon the stronger, from a need for nourishment; it wants to find shelter, wants to become one with it if possible. The stronger on the contrary fends things off, it does not want to perish this way; on the contrary, in growing it splits itself in two and into several parts. The greater the pressure for unity, the more one can infer weakness; the greater the pressure for variety, difference, internal dissolution, the more strength is there. The drive to approach — and the drive to repel something are the bond in the inorganic and well as the organic world. The whole separation is a prejudice. The will to power in every combination of forces, fending off the stronger, pouncing on the weaker is more correct. NB. Processes as “beings.”?? 36[22]*° The connection between the inorganic and the organic must lie in the repelling force that every atom of force exerts. Life would be defined as an enduring form of the process of force determinations, where the different combatants for their part grow unequally. The extent to which a resistance lies even in obeying; one’s individual power is by no means surrendered. Likewise in commanding there is a concession that the absolute power of the opponent is not vanquished, not incorporated, dissolved. “Obeying” like “commanding” are forms of jousting. 36[23]°! Continuous transitions do not allow us to speak of “individual” etc.; the “number” of beings is itself in flux. We would not speak of time and know nothing of movement if we did not, in a crude manner, believe we saw “things at rest” beside “things in motion.” Just as little would we speak of cause and effect, and without the erroneous conception of “empty space” we would not have arrived at all at the conception of space. [Page 133] 126 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS The principle of identity has as background the “appearance” that identical things exist. A world of becoming could not be “comprehended,” not “known” in the strict sense: only insofar as the “comprehending” and “knowing” intellect finds an already created crude world, pieced together entirely from illusory things, but become firm, insofar as this kind of illusion has preserved life — only to this extent does something like “knowledge” exist: i.e., a measuring of earlier and more recent errors against one another. 36[24] The sun: its movements are results 1) of the drive to pounce on the planets 2) this brings forth an approach to all 3) defending itself against a stronger sun 36[25]223 I believe in absolute space, as a substratum of force: the latter limits and structures. Time eternal. But in itself there is no space, nor time: “changes” are only appearances (or sense-processes for us); if we nonetheless posit regular recurrence among these, then nothing is proven thereby but this simple fact, that it has always happened this way. The feeling that the post hoc? is a propter hoc? is easy to deduce as a misunderstanding; it is understandable. But appearances cannot be “causes”! 36[26] “Subject” “object” “predicate” — these separations are made up and are

now slapped like schemata on all apparent facts. The false fundamental observation is that I believe am the one who does something, who suffers something, who “has” something, who “has” a quality.*° This “doing” “suffering” “having” ——— 36[27] Philosophy, in the only way I still grant it validity, as the most universal form of history, as the attempt to somehow describe Heraclitean becoming and abbreviate it in symbols (to translate it so to speak into a kind of illusory being and to mummify it) [Page 134] 36 JUNE-JULY 1885 127 36[28]?” That “heredity,” as something quite unexplained, cannot be used for explanation, but only for describing, for fixing a problem. Precisely this applies to the “capacity for adaptation.” In fact nothing is explained through morphological representation, supposing it were completed, but a tremendous fact is described. How an organ can be used to some purpose, that is not explained. In these things as little would be explained with the assumption of *causae finales*’ as with *causae efficientes*.° The concept “causa” is only a means of expression, nothing more, a means for describing. 36[29]*° There are analogies, e.g., to our memory another memory that makes itself noticeable in forms in heredity and development. To our inventing and experimenting, an inventing in the application of tools for new purposes etc. That which we call our consciousness is innocent of all essential processes of our preservation and our growth; and no mind could be so subtle that it could construe more than a machine — which is far exceeded by every organic process. 36[30] One is unfair toward Descartes if one takes lightly his invocation of God’s credibility. In fact, from the start it is only with the assumption of a God who is morally similar to us that “truth” and the search for truth are something that promises success and has meaning. Leaving this God aside, it is permitted to ask whether being deceived does not belong to the conditions of life. 36[31]4142 The triumphant concept “force” with which our physicists have ousted God from the world requires one more enhancement: an internal world must be attributed to it, to which I refer as “will to power,” i.e., as an insatiable demand for displaying [Page 135] 128 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS power; or application, exertion of power, as creative drive etc. The physicists cannot rid the “effect at a distance” from their principles: just as little as a repelling force (or attracting one) There is no helping it: one must grasp all motion, all “appearances,” all “laws” only as symptoms of an internal event and use to the limit the analogy of the human being.*? In the animal it is possible to deduce all its drives from the will to power: likewise all functions of organic life from this single source. 36[32] Leibniz is dangerous, as a proper German who needs foregrounds and foreground-philosophies, daring and mysterious to the extreme in himself, but without nobility Spinoza is deeper more comprehensive more hiding in caves than Descartes: Pascal in turn deeper than Spinoza. Measured against such hermits of the spirit and conscience Hume and Locke are humans of the surface;

— — — 36[33] On the Critique of the German Soul. 36[34]* Of the world interpretations that have been attempted so far, the mechanistic today seems to stand triumphantly in the foreground: clearly it has good conscience on its side; and no science believes for itself in progress or success unless it is won with the help of mechanistic procedures. Everyone knows these procedures: one leaves “reason” and “purposes” out of it, as much as possible, one shows that in due time everything can evolve from everything, one does not conceal a gloating grin when once again the “apparent intentionality in the fate” of a plant or an egg yolk is traced to pressure and thrust: in sum, one wholeheartedly honors, if a humorous expression is permitted in so serious a matter, the principle of the greatest possible stupidity. Meanwhile precisely in these distinguished intellects who belong to this movement a premonition, an anxiety can be detected, as [Page 136] 36 JUNE-JULY 1885 129 if this theory had a hole that before too long could become its final hole: I mean the hole that is their rock bottom*® from which they will leak when they are in their moment of highest need. Pressure and stress themselves cannot be “explained,” one cannot be rid of the *actio in distans*“? — we have lost our belief in even the ability to explain and we admit with a peevish expression that describing and not explaining, that the dynamic world interpretation with its denial of “empty space,” of particle atoms, will soon hold sway over physicists: whereby of course in addition to dynamis an inner quality — — — 36[35]° Using the Body as a Guide. — Supposing that “the soul” was an attractive and mysterious idea from which philosophers justifiably parted only with reluctance — perhaps that which they are now learning to exchange for it is even more attractive, more mysterious. The human body, in which the entire most distant and most recent past of all organic development again becomes lively and embodied, through which and over and beyond which a tremendous inaudible stream appears to flow: the body is a more amazing idea than the ancient “soul.” 36[36]° At all times people have believed better in the body as our most certain being, in sum as the ego, than in the spirit (or the “soul” or “the subject,” as school discourse now says instead of soul). No one ever hatched the notion that his stomach could be understood as a foreign, perhaps divine stomach: but his thoughts as “given from beyond,” his valuations as “inspired by a god,” comprehending his instincts as demonic activity: for this tendency and taste of human beings there are testimonies from all the ages of humanity. Even today, especially among artists, there is abundant evidence of a kind of amazement and reverential suspension of judgment when they are presented with the question of how they succeeded in their best throw [Page 137] 130 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS and from which world the creative idea came to them: when they ask in this manner, they have something like innocence and childish shame, they scarcely dare to say “this came from me, this was my hand that threw the dice.” — Conversely, even those philosophers and religious

people who had the most compelling grounds in their logic and piety to take their corporeality as a deception, and indeed as an overcome and dispensed-with deception, were not able to avoid recognizing the stupid fact that the body has not gone away: for which the most remarkable testimony is to be found partly in Paul, partly in the Vedanta philosophy. But what ultimately does strength of belief mean! Therefore it could still be a very stupid belief! — What needs contemplating here: — And in the end, if the belief in the body is only the result of an inference: supposing it were a false inference, as the idealists maintain: is it not a question mark against the credibility of the spirit itself that it is the cause of such false inferences? Supposing multiplicity, and space and time and motion (and whatever else may be the presuppositions of a belief in corporeality) were errors, what suspicion will be aroused against the spirit by that which occasioned such presuppositions in us! Enough, the belief in the body is for the time being still a stronger belief than the belief in the spirit; and whoever wants to undermine it, at the same time most thoroughly also undermines the belief in the authority of the spirit. 361571" I. Human All Too Human: with this title the will to a great separation is signaled, the attempt of an individual to free himself from all kinds of prejudices that speak in favor of human beings and to walk all paths that lead high enough, at least for a moment, to look down on humans. Not to despise the despicable in humans, but instead to question deep down to the ultimate grounds whether even in the highest and the [Page 138] 36 JUNE-JULY 1885 131 best and in everything of which humans so far have been proud, whether in this pride itself and the harmless superficial confidence of its valuations there is not something still left to despise; this not innocuous task was one means among all the means to which a greater, a more comprehensive task compelled me. Does anyone want to walk these paths with me? I advise no one to do so. — But you want to? Then let's go. 36[38] Goethe is an exception: he lived among Germans in a subtle manner sheltered and disguised; Schiller belongs to those Germans who loved the big gleaming words and pomp gestures of virtue (— even his taste for Kantian morality and its absolute command-tone belongs here —) It hurts the Germans to admit to themselves how much they have been the Germans of Kotzebue" (and to a good extent not yet —); and that life-threatening fanatic Sand perhaps only took his revenge in the wrong place, as so often happens. Jans(syen 36[39] If there is anything that accrues to the honor of contemporary Germans it is that they no longer tolerate the big gleaming glittering Schillerian words that their grandfathers — — — 36[40] The small German towns as Kotzebue painted them — and the painting was good — are made in the image of Weimardwellers, at the time of Schiller and Goethe. 36[41] The pettiness and pitifulness of the German soul, its partly hedonistic, partly jealous sitting-in-the-corner, its incarnate "small town atmosphere," to invoke Kotzebue, its "frog-perspective" for all higher things, to use the language of

painters — how painful — — — [Page 139] 132 UNPUBLISHED
 FRAGMENTS 36[42] If intellect, industriousness and capability alone were considered, the Prussian Jews would already be in possession of the higher state offices, especially in the administrative sector: in sum, they would also have the “power” in their hands (just as they already have it — judging by manifold evidence — “in their pockets”). What excludes them from this is their inability to represent power: the Jews even in their fatherland have not been a ruling caste: their eye does not convince, their tongue easily runs too swiftly and trips itself up, their anger does not know the deep honest roaring of a lion, their stomach does not tolerate great feasting and their understanding does not tolerate strong wine — their arms and legs do not permit them any proud affects (often twitching in their hands is I know not what kind of — memory —); and even the manner in which a Jew mounts a horse (or a Jewish musician arrives at his theme — “the Jewish leap” —) is not innocuous and lets us know that the Jews have never been a knightly race. If the Jews are frequently perceived as unfit for the dignity of serving as judges, then what is condemned here is not their morality, but only their inability to represent this morality. Now from this it immediately follows that the Jew of Prussia must be a diminished and atrophied kind of Jew; for in itself the Oriental understands representation incomparably better than, say, a north German: — Delacroix. This degeneration of the Jew is connected to a wrong climate and being neighbors of ugly and oppressed Slavs Hungarians and Germans: among Portuguese and Moors the higher race of Jews is preserved, indeed on the whole the solemnity of tone and a kind of sanctifying of passion has perhaps never on earth been more beautifully portrayed than by certain Jews of the Old Testament: even the Greeks could have learned something from them! 36143] The dangers of the Jewish soul are: 1) it seeks to nest itself parasitically somewhere 2) it knows how to “adapt,” as the [Page 14] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 7 34[28] Superstition: to believe in the being,” in the absolute, in pure spirit, in absolute knowledge, in absolute value, in the thing in itself! These approaches are riddled with a contradictio everywhere. 34129] Skeptical Objections. 34130] Perception on the part of our senses happens to us unconsciously: everything that becomes conscious to us is already processed perceptions 34[31] He makes the great detachment for himself — not because he demands it of others or even sees it as his duty to communicate it to and force it on others. 34132] The great millennia-long ebb in the invention of values 34[33]” The Lawgivers of the Future. 1. Descent. 2. The Most Bound Spirit. 3. The Great Detachment. 4. Suffering from Human Beings. 5. The New Will. 6. The Hammer. 34134] My version of acedia*® — the opposite of that of the monks. I am perturbed about my overly large compassion: I am pleased when my ego is alert and in good spirits.” [Page 140] 36 JUNE-JULY 1885 133 natural scientists say, in this manner they “have become born actors, like the octopus,” which as Theognis

sings, borrows its color from the cliff to which it adheres.’ Their talent and even more their tendency and inclination to both seem tremendous; their habit of expending much spirit and persistence on very small gains has left a fateful furrow in their character: so that even the most respectable wholesalers of the Jewish money market cannot bring themselves, if the circumstances warrant, to (not) cold-bloodedly reach for little mesquinen^{TM4} overcharges of the kind that would make a Prussian financier blush. 36[44] The future of German culture rests on the sons of Prussian officers 36[45]”° A. The Jews the oldest and purest race. Beauty of the women. B. The Jews the actors: in a democratic age: reduction of the literary man to the actor C. Problem of merging the European aristocracy or rather the young Prussian nobleman with Jewesses. 36[46] German atheism. the school master culture. German pessimism. 36[47] The dangers of the Jewish soul: parasitism and acting The Jew does not “represent” The school master culture. German pessimism. The hermit: Teutonomania. German music. The literary men. [Page 141] 134 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS The women. Mistrust of modern ideas. German anarchism. 36[48] Hostility toward everything that smacks of literary men and popular enlightenment, especially toward everything that ruins women, deforms women — for spiritual enlightenment is an infallible means of making humans insecure, weaker willed, more dependent and needy of support, in sum of developing the herd animal in human beings: which is why so far all great artists of governing (Confucius in China, the imperium romanum, Napoleon, the papacy at the time when it successfully had power and not only the will to power where the ruling instinct culminated so far, also made use of spiritual enlightenment; at least they allowed it to reign (like the popes of the Renaissance) The self-deception of the masses on this point e.g., in all democracies, is extremely valuable: the diminution and governability of humans is striven for as “progress”! 36[49]”* On German Pessimism. — Dimming, pessimistic coloring necessarily follow as a result of the Enlightenment. Around 1770 one already noticed a decrease in cheerfulness; women believed, with that feminine instinct that always sides with virtue, that immorality was to blame: Galiani hit the mark: he quotes Voltaire’s verse’ — If I now presume to be out in front of Voltaire and even Galiani — who was something much profounder — by a couple of centuries in terms of enlightenment: how far therefore must I have come in terms of dimming! This is also true: and early on I was cautious with a kind of regret of German and Christian narrowness and the logical inconsistency of Schopenhauerian or even Leopardian pessimism and looked for the most principled forms (— Asia —) I do not count E(duard) vlon} H(artmann) among the continuators of pessimism, on the contrary among the “pleasant [Page 142] 36 JUNE-JULY 1885 135 literatures” — — — etc. But in order to bear this extreme pessimism (as it echoes forth from time to time from my Birth of Tragedy) living alone “without

God and morality,” I had to invent a counterpart for myself. Perhaps I know best why only humans laugh: they alone suffer so deeply that they had to invent laughter. The unhappy and melancholy animal is, as is only fair, the most cheerful. 36[50] On the German Lyric Poets, — 36[51] South and East. 36[52] Brahms, no “event,” no exception, no breach in the chain before Wagner, on the contrary one link more, a — — — If one excludes what he occasionally sacrificed so to speak to a hospitable genius of foreign ways and human beings — also sacrifices of piety for great teachers, old and new, included — then he alone is the musician who so far has claim to the characterization “the north German musician” 36[53]° The Germans are nothing yet, but they are becoming something; therefore they still have no culture — therefore they cannot yet have a culture! This is my proposition: let it offend whomever it must: namely whoever has Teutonomania in his head (or on his shield)! — They are nothing yet: that is: they are everything. They are becoming something: that is, they will someday stop being everything. The latter is at bottom only a wish, scarcely still a hope; fortunately a wish according to which one can live, a matter of will, of work, of discipline, of cultivation as well as a matter of unwillingness, of longing, of renunciation, of discontent, even of embitterment: in sum, we Germans want something that before us no one yet has wanted — we want something more! [Page 143] 136 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS That this “German who becomes and not yet is” — deserves something better than today’s German “education,” that all “who are becoming” have to be enraged wherever they perceive a satisfaction in this sphere, a brazen “resting on one’s laurels” or “anointing oneself”: this is my second proposition, concerning which I have also not changed my thinking. 36[54] How a theologian today can have a good conscience with his Christianness is incomprehensible and inaccessible to me; but there is adequate good conscience in him — it seems there must not be much to this “good conscience”! 36[55]* “German.” Questions and Dashes. Thoughts on Discipline and Cultivation. 36[56] Offended pride, annoyance at having loved where one could have despised, an added melancholy over the resulting emptiness and gap, finally the bite of intellectual vanity that said “you let yourself be cheated” — : this was the next experience. But a philosophical human being drives all he has experienced into the universal, all that is individual grows into chains 36[57] The Asiatic h(umans) are a hundred times more magnificent than the European 36[58] The jungle-vegetation “human being” always appears where the struggle for power has been waged longest. The great humans. [Page 144] 36 JUNE-JULY 1885 137 36[59] Even the development of the highest forms of intelligence has been cultivated under unfreedom and counter-pressure. So far we have nothing to thank the “liberal spirit” for. One underestimates what refinement for the spirit has accompanied the agony of conscience of a simultaneously Christian and scientific-logical

interpretation of the world. 36[60] “On the Critique of the Modern Soul.” [Page 145] [37 = W I 6a. June-July 1885] 371]! Many a hearty objection could be made to that which I dare to present in this book, certainly from up close, and even more from a distance. I have anticipated one part of these objections myself, thanks to my manifold practice in interrogating and in dueling with myself but unfortunately I have also always answered them in advance: so that up till now the entire burden of my “truths” has rested on me. One will understand that it has been a matter of burdensome truths here; and if there is one faith that makes us blessed, well then, here is a faith that does not do that! But why should things be organized t(o) bring us pleasure? — Even though precisely this time, speaking frankly, I would enjoy the pleasure of being refuted. — And if on the other hand knowledge — — — us, what is knowledge for? — Ultimately perhaps this, too, is only a question of time: in the end we get along even with the devil. And if things are not supposed to be organized to bring us pleasure, who could prevent us from — organizing them to that end? 37[2]” It is bad taste to want to agree with many. At bottom my friend Satis is enough for me: surely you know who that is? Satis sunt mihi pauci, satis est unus, satis est nullus? And in the end this is what remains: the great things are left over and preserved [Page 146] 37 JUNE-JULY 1885 139 for the great, the abysses for the profound, the delicacies and shudders for the refined, and on the whole and in sum, everything rare for the rare. My judgment is my judgment: anyone else does not easily have a right to it. — And you, my dear Mr. Neighbor, you who are just now peeking over my shoulder at my book, you even insist on agreeing with me on this? You look into this book and say Yes to it? Away with you! I absolutely do not want to become suspicious, on account of you, of what I just wrote. For I, too, love truth, like all philosophers: all philosophers so far loved their truths — — 37[3]* I forgot to say that such philosophers are cheerful and that they like to sit in the abyss of a perfectly bright sky: — they need different means to endure life than other people, for they suffer differently: (namely just as much from the profundity of their contempt for humans, as from their love). — The most suffering animal on earth invented for itself —/aughter. 3714] Morality and Physiology. — We consider it a hastiness that precisely human consciousness has been regarded for so long as the highest stage of organic development and as the most amazing of all earthly things, indeed as their blossom and “goal” so to speak. What is more amazing on the contrary is the body: one cannot cease to admire how the human body has become possible: how such a tremendous unity of living beings can grow and for a time exist, each one dependent and subservient and yet in a certain sense on the other hand commanding and acting from its own will — : and this occurs obviously not through consciousness! Compared to this “wonder of wonders” consciousness is just a “tool” and no more — in the same sense that the stomach is a tool for it. The magnificent binding together of the most

manifold life, the order and arrangement of the higher and lower activities, the thousand-fold obedience which is not a blind, even less a mechanistic but rather a selecting, [Page 147] 140 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS circumspect, considerate, even resisting obedience — this whole phenomenon “body,” measured by intellectual standards, is as much superior to our consciousness, our “spirit,” our conscious thinking, feeling, willing as algebra is to multiplication tables. The “nerve- and brain-apparatus” for producing thinking, feeling, willing in the first place is not as subtle and “divinely” constructed: on the contrary to me it seems that precisely for this, for thinking, feeling, willing, really no “apparatus” at all is needed, rather that this, this precisely — is “the thing itself.” On the contrary a tremendous synthesis of living beings and intellects such as this, which is called “human being,” will only be able to live when that subtle connecting- and mediating system, and through it lightning-fast communication among all these higher and lower beings are created — and moreover exclusively by living mediators: but this is a moral and not a mechanistic problem! Today we have forbidden ourselves to fantasize about “unity,” about the “soul,” about the “person”: with such hypotheses we only complicate the problem, so much is clear. And even those smallest living beings that constitute our body (more accurately: whose working-together is the best metaphor for that which we call “body” —) are not regarded by us as soul-atoms, but instead as something growing, struggling, self-increasing and again dying out: so that their number changes erratically, and our life like any life is simultaneously a continuous dying. Therefore there are as many “consciousnesses” in a human being as there are beings, in every moment of his existence, that constitute his body. What we usually conceive of as a singular “consciousness,” the intellect, is distinguished precisely by the fact that it remains protected and closed off from the innumerable multiplicity in the experiences of these multiple consciousnesses and, as a consciousness of a higher order, as a ruling multiplicity and aristocracy, it is presented with only a selection of experiences, moreover only those that are simplified and rendered surveyable and comprehensible, hence falsified experiences — so that for its part it can [Page 148] 37 JUNE-JULY 1885 141 continue this process of simplifying and rendering surveyable, hence of falsifying, and can prepare that which we commonly call “a will” — each such act of will presupposes as it were the appointment of a dictator. But that which presents this selection to our intellect, which already simplified, compared, interpreted the experiences in advance, is in any case not this intellect: just as little as it is that which executes the will, which picks up a pale, thin and extremely imprecise value- and power-representation and translates it into living power and precise value-standards. And precisely the same kind of operation that plays out here must continuously play out on all deeper levels in the behavior of all these higher and lower beings toward one another: this same selecting and

presenting of experiences, this abstracting and thinking in unison, this willing, this translating back of the always very imprecise willing into precise activity. Using the body as a guide, as I mentioned, we learn that our life is only possible through an interplay of many intelligences of very unequal value and therefore only through a constant thousand-fold obeying and commanding — morally spoken: through the incessant exercise of many virtues. And how could one cease to speak morally! — Prattling in this manner I surrendered myself in unbridled fashion to my didactic streak, for I was blissful to have someone who could tolerate listening to me. And yet, at precisely this point Ariadne could tolerate it no longer — you see, the story took place during my first stay on Naxos — : “but sir,” she said, “you are speaking Pig-German!” — “German,” I answered cheerfully, “simply German! Leave the pig out, my dear goddess! You underestimate the difficulty of saying subtle things in German!” — “Subtle things!” cried Ariadne, appalled: “but that was just positivism! Philosophizing with tusks! Conceptual-mishmash and muck from a hundred philosophies! What is that supposed to mean!” — and here she played impatiently with her famous thread, which once guided her Theseus through the labyrinth. — Thus it came to light that Ariadne was around two millennia behind in her philosophical education. [Page 149] 142 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 3715] In books of aphorisms like mine strictly forbidden lengthy things and thought-chains stand between and behind short aphorisms; and some of it may be questionable enough for Oedipus and his sphinx. I do not write essays: they are for asses and readers of newspapers. Speeches even less. My Unfashionable Observations I aimed as a young person at young people to whom I spoke of my experiences and vows, in order to lure them into my labyrinth — at German youths: but I have been persuaded to believe that German youths have died out. Well then: now I no longer have any reason to be “eloquent” in that former manner; today — I would probably no longer be able to do it. Whoever has sat together days a(nd) nights and year-in, year-out with his soul in the most intimate discord and dialogue, whoever in his cave — it could be a labyrinth a(nd) also a gold mine — turned into a cave-bear or gold digger, whoever like me allowed and allows all kinds of thoughts, second thoughts and questionable matters to run through his head and over his heart, which he would not always communicate, even if he had kindred spirits and boisterous brave comrades around him: even his concepts ultimately acquire their own twilight color, an aroma as much of profundity as of mold; something incommunicable and recalcitrant that chills any curious bystander: — and a hermit-philosophy, even if it were written with a lion’s claw, would still only look like a philosophy of “quotation marks.” 37(6)° In the writings of a hermit one also hears something of the echo of the wasteland, something of whispered tones and the shy looking-around of loneliness: his strongest words and even screams still sound as it were like a new and more dangerous kind of

silence, of concealment. 371717 Supposing one were to imagine a philosopher as a great educator, powerful enough to stand on his lonely heights and pull long chains of generations up to him: then one would also [Page 15] 8

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 34135] 1. Abelard wanted to bring reason to ecclesiastical authority: ultimately Descartes found that all authority resides in reason only.” 2. The self-overcoming of reason inner problem of Pascal — for the sake of Christian “faith.” 34[36] The problem of “faith” is actually: whether instinct has more value than reasoning, and why! Beneath the many disputes over “knowledge and faith,” utilitarianism) and intuitionism this question of value estimation is concealed. Socrates naively sided with reason, against instinct. (At bottom though he had indeed followed all moral instincts, only with a false motivation: as if the motives came from reason. Likewise Plato etc.)

Involuntarily Plato sought to demonstrate that reason and instinct want the same. Likewise up till today Kant, Schopenhauer, the English. In “faith” the instinct of obedience toward the highest authority is uppermost, therefore a single instinct. The categorical imperative is a desired instinct, where this instinct and reason are one. 34137] Kant, a subtle mind, a pedantic soul 34[38] NB. I should be forgiven this presumptuous assertion: precisely because I have a higher and deeper, also more scientific conception of woman than the emancipators and emancipatresses have of her, I resist emancipation: I know better where their strength is and say to them: “they know not what they do.”” They are dissolving their instincts! with their strivings of today. [Page 150] 37 JUNE-JULY 1885 143 have to grant him the uncanny prerogatives of the great educator. An educator never says what he himself is thinking, but always only what he thinks about a thing in relation to its use to the one he is educating. He must not be detected in this dissemblance; it is part of his mastery that we believe in his honesty. He must be capable of all means of discipline and castigation: some natures he advances only through the whiplashes of scorn, others, lethargic, indecisive, cowardly, vain, perhaps with exaggerated praise. Such an educator is beyond good and evil; but no one is allowed to know it. 37[8]° It is approaching, irrefutably, hesitatingly, terrible as fate, the great task and question: how should the earth as a whole be governed? And for what should “the human being” as a whole — and no longer a people, a race — be bred and cultivated? The legislative moralities are the major means by which one can shape the human into what a creative and profound will prefers: supposing that such an artist-will of the highest order holds the power in his hands and can assert his creating will over long stretches of time, in the form of legislations, religions and customs. Such humans of great creativity, the truly great human as I understand it, will be sought in vain today and probably for a long time to come: they are missing — : until finally, after much disappointment, one has to begin to understand why they are missing and that there is nothing more hostile standing in the way of their emergence and development for now

and for a long time than what today is straightforwardly called “the morality” in Europe: as if no other existed and no other were allowed to exist — that herd-morality referred to earlier, which strives with all its powers for universal green pasture-happiness on earth, namely security, absence of danger, comfort, ease of living and to top it off, “if all goes well,” even hopes to get rid of every kind of shepherd and bellwether. Its two most abundantly preached doctrines are: “equal rights” and “sympathy for all who suffer” [Page 151] 144 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS — and suffering itself is construed by them as something that must absolutely be abolished. That such “ideas” can still be modern sends a bad message about — — — But whoever has thoroughly reflected on where and how the plant human being has so far grown most robustly, has to surmise that this occurred under the reverse conditions: that for this the danger of its situation must grow immensely, its power of invention and dissimulation must struggle to the top under long pressure and compulsion, its life-will must be intensified to the point of unconditional will to power and to super-power, and that danger, harshness, violence, danger in the streets a(nd) in the heart, inequality of rights, stealth, stoicism, tempter-arts, a(nd) devilishness of every kind, in sum, the opposite of all herd-desiderata are essential for the elevation of the type human being. A morality with such inverted aims, that seeks to cultivate humans into the heights, instead of into comfort and mediocrity, a morality with the aim of cultivating a ruling caste — the future rulers of the earth — must, in order to be taught, introduce itself in association with the existing moral code and under its words and appearances; but that for this many transition- and deception-methods have to be invented, and that, because the lifespan of a single human means practically nothing with respect to the execution of such long-term tasks and aims, above all first a new species must be cultivated, in which that specific will, that specific instinct will be guaranteed longevity through many generations: a new ruler-species and caste — this is just as understandable as the long and not easy to articulate et cetera of this thought. To prepare an inversion of values for a specific strong species of human of the highest spirituality and will-power and for this purpose to slowly and cautiously unleash in them a large quantity of reined-in and slandered instincts: whoever reflects on this belongs among us, to the free spirits — to be sure to a newer kind of “free spirit” than previous ones: for the latter desired roughly the opposite. To this group belong, it seems to me, above all the pessimists of Europe, the poets and thinkers of an outraged idealism, insofar as their [Page 152] 37 JUNE-JULY 1885 145 dissatisfaction with existence on the whole also forces them at least logically into dissatisfaction with the current human; likewise certain insatiably ambitious artists who heedlessly and unconditionally fight for the special rights of higher humans and against “the herd animal,” and who, using the seductive methods of art, lull to sleep all herd instincts and herd caution in the more select spirits; thirdly, finally,

all those critics and historians by whom the successfully begun discovery of the old world — it is the work of the new Columbus, of the German spirit — is courageously continued — for we are still at the beginning of this conquest. For in the ancient world there ruled indeed a different, a more ruler-oriented morality than today; and the ancient human under the educating sway of his morality was a stronger and deeper human than the human of today: — he alone so far was “the human who turned out well.” However, the seduction that is exerted by antiquity on humans who have turned out well, i.e., on strong and enterprising souls, is even today the finest and most effective of all antidemocratic and antichristian seductions: as it was already at the time of the Renaissance. 37[9]° I see beyond all these national wars, new “empires” and whatever else stands in the foreground: what concerns me — for I see it preparing itself slowly and hesitatingly — this is the One Europe. Among all more comprehensive and profound humans of this century the real total work of their soul was to prepare that new synthesis and to experimentally anticipate “the European” of the future: only in their weaker hours, or when they became old, did they fall back into the national narrowness of their “fatherlands” — then they were “patriots.” I am thinking of people like Napoleon, Goethe, Beethoven, Stendhal, Heinrich Heine, Schopenhauer; perhaps Richard Wagner also belongs here, about whom, a type of German obscurity who turned out well, absolutely nothing can be said without such a “perhaps.” But by way of explanation, standing [Page 153] 146

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS alongside that which stirs and takes shape in such spirits as a need for a new unity or already is a new unity with new needs, is a great economic fact: the small states of Europe, I mean all our current states and “empires,” must in a short time become economically untenable given the absolute drive of big commerce and trade for a final limit, for world commerce and world trade. (Money alone is already forcing Europe to gather itself together into a single power at some time.) But in order to join the struggle for governing the earth with decent prospects — it is plain as day against whom this struggle will be aimed — Europe probably needs to come to a serious “understanding” with England: the colonies of England are needed for that struggle just as much as today’s Germany needs the colonies of Holland for practicing its new mediator and broker role.!° For no one believes anymore that England itself is strong enough to maintain its old role for even fifty years; it will be destroyed by the impossibility of excluding the *homines novi* from government, and there must be no such change of parties if these long-lasting things are to be — — — today one must first be a soldier in order not to lose one’s credit as a merchant. Enough: in this as in other things the next century will be found in the footsteps of Napoleon, the foremost and most highly anticipatory human being of modern times. For the tasks of the next centuries “public” and parliamentarianism are the least suitable forms of organization. 37 [10]!? I differentiate, among superior

humans as well as among peoples, those who want to have the world round, whole and firm — big perhaps, very big but whole and not at all “infinite” — and those who love the clouds: because clouds veil, because clouds make us “intuit.” To the latter, among peoples, belong the Germans; and therefore it is not advisable for a thinker of the opposite disposition to build his cottage among them. The air is too cloudy for him there. German “simplicity,” German faith in the “pure fool”: he always translates that into French [Page 154] 37 JUNE-JULY 1885 147 and calls it /a niaiserie allemande.³ The German “mind”:⁴ by that he literally means what Goethe meant by it: “Indulgence toward weaknesses of others and oneself.” German bad taste: he finds it hair-raising, — I had an opportunity once to point this out in the case of a senile book by Strauss. Seen from abroad, one is allowed to doubt whether Germany can come up now with ten men who are discerning in matters of literary form and have profundity. For profundity is necessary in order to grasp the delicate needs for form generally; only from the depths, from the abyss does one enjoy all the happiness found in bright, confident, colorful, superficial things of all kinds. But the Germans believe they are profound when they feel grave and melancholy: — they sweat when they think, sweating to them is regarded as proof of their “seriousness.” Their spirits are clumsy, the spirit of beer is powerful even in their thoughts — and this they even call their “idealism”! To be sure, the Germans, at least as they themselves believe, have taken precisely this idealism far, “as far as the stars,” and they might be allowed, if only German modesty permitted, to boldly seat themselves beside the Greeks in this regard, as the famous people of “poets and thinkers.” Or, to let this self-confidence speak immodestly for once, and moreover in the verses of a great idealist: “Why praise the Greeks to excess! “They must slink into darkness, “When softly stirs the German muse. “Horace in Flemming simmers, “In Opitz Naso shimmers, “In Greiff the gloom of Seneca.” Leibniz. 3701)” Socialism — as a form of tyranny of the paltriest and stupidest, of the shallow, of the jealous and the three-quarters-actors, thought through to the end — is in fact the ultimate conclusion of modern ideas and their latent anarchism: but in the tepid air of democratic well-being the capacity for coming to conclusions or even coming [Page 155] 148 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS to conclusion withers away. One follows — but one no longer draws conclusions. Therefore socialism on the whole is a hopeless, sour affair: and nothing is more fun to watch than the contradiction between the poisonous and desperate faces made by today’s socialists — and what pitiful crushed emotions are betrayed by their style! — and the harmless little-lamb-happiness of their hopes and desires. In many places in Europe it can lead to occasional coups and attacks on their part: the next century will thoroughly “rumble” here and there in its stomach, and the Paris Commune, which also has its mouthpieces and advocates in Germany (e.g. in the philosophical grimace-maker and swamp-

salamander E(u)gen D(ü)hring in Berlin), was possibly only a milder case of indigestion, compared to what is coming. Nevertheless there will always be too many property owners for socialism to be anything more than an attack of sickness: and these property owners are to a man of one belief: “you have to own something to be something.” But this is the oldest and healthiest of all instincts: I would add “you have to want more than you have in order to become more.” For thus rings the doctrine that is preached by life itself to everything that lives: the morality of development. Possessing and wanting to have more, in a word, growth — this is life itself. In the doctrine of socialism a “will to denial of life” is badly concealed; it has to be failed humans or races who think up such a doctrine. Indeed, I wish it would be demonstrated by a few big experiments that in a socialist society life denies itself} cuts off its own roots. The earth is big enough, and human beings are still unexhausted enough, that a practical lesson and demonstratio ad absurdum’? of this kind still has to seem desirable to me, even if it were gained and paid with a tremendous expenditure of human life. Still, even as the restless mole under the soil of a society rolling into stupidity, socialism can be something useful and healing: it delays “peace on earth” and the whole good-nature-izing of the democratic herd animal, it forces Europeans to preserve spirit, namely cunning and caution, to not entirely swear off the manly and warrior virtues, and to maintain a modicum of spirit — of clarity, dryness and coldness of the spirit [Page 156] 37 JUNE-JULY 1885 149 — it protects Europe for the time being from the marasmus femininus” that threatens it. 37 [12] In the main matter I consider the artists to be right more than all philosophers so far: they did not lose the great trail on which life walks, they loved the things “of this world” — they loved their senses. To strive for desensualization: that seems to me a misunderstanding or an illness or a cure, where it is not merely hypocrisy or self-deception. I wish for myself and for all those who live, who are allowed to live — without the anxieties of a Puritan-conscience an ever greater spiritualization and multiplication of the senses; indeed we want to be grateful to the senses for their subtlety, fullness and power, and in exchange offer them the best of the spirit that we have. What do the priestly and metaphysical denunciations of the senses concern us! We no longer need this denunciation: it is a sign of having turned out well when someone clings like Goethe with ever greater joy and heartiness to “the things of the world”: — for that is the way he holds on to the great conception of the human being, that the human being becomes the transfigurer of existence when he learns to transfigure himself.2? — But what are you saying? someone objects. Are not precisely today the worst pessimists among the artists) What do you think for example of Richard Wagner? Is that not a pessimist? — I have to rub my ears: (you are right, I forgot something for a moment.) 37113] Historians today want too much and they all sin against good taste: they force themselves into the souls

of humans to whose rank and in whose company they do not belong. What for example does such an agitated sweating plebeian like Michelet have to do with Napoleon! It makes no difference whether he hates or loves him, but because he sweats, he does not belong in his vicinity. What does that mediocre animal, elegant in the [Page 157] 150 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS worst sense of the word, have to do with this same Napoleon! he makes us laugh, the little man, when he measures the great man against Caesar, Hannibal and Frederick with the mien of a wise judge. I value it higher when someone acknowledges even as a historian when the ground is too hot or too holy for his foot; but a historian who “removes his shoes” at the right time, or puts them on and walks away is a rare bird today, in this age of ingenuous shamelessness. The German historians among whom the “historical sense” was invented — now the French are rehearsing it — reveal, each and every one of them, that they do not come from a ruling caste: as knowing ones they are intrusive and show a lack of finer shame. 37[14] I have named my unconscious workers and way-pavers. But where could I seek with a bit of hope for my kind of philosopher himself, at least for my need for new philosophers? Only where a noble way of thinking reigns, one that believes in slavery and in many degrees of bondage as the prerequisite of any higher culture; where a creative way of thinking reigns, which does not set the world’s goal as the happiness of repose, the “Sabbath of all Sabbaths” and honors peace itself as a means to new wars; a way of thinking that prescribes laws for the future, which treats itself and everything of the present harshly and tyrannically for the sake of the future; a heedless, “immoral” way of thinking that wants to cultivate to greatness the good and wicked qualities of humans equally, because it trusts in its strength to deploy both in the right place — in the place where both are essential to one another. But whoever seeks philosophers in this manner today, what prospects does he have to find what he seeks? Is it not probable that he, searching with the best Diogenes-lantern, would run around day and night in vain? Our age has the opposite instincts: above all and in the first place it wants comfort; secondly it wants publicity and that grand noise of actors, that grand boom-boom that corresponds to its fairground-taste; thirdly it wants everyone to [Page 158] 37 JUNE-JULY 1885 II crawl on their belly in deepest subservience before the greatest of all lies — this lie is called “equality of human beings” — and it honors exclusively the virtues that make equal and assign equal rights. But in this way our age fundamentally opposes the emergence of the philosopher as I understand him, even though it believes in all innocence that it promotes him. Indeed, everyone today is lamenting about how bad the philosophers used to have it, jammed between the stake, bad conscience and presumptuous church father wisdom: but the truth is that precisely these circumstances provided for more favorable conditions for the education of a powerful, comprehensive, devious and audaciously daring spirituality than the

conditions of contemporary life. Today a different kind of spirit, namely the demagoguespirit, the actor-spirit, perhaps even the beaver- and ant-spirit of scholars has favorable conditions for its emergence. But for superior artists things are already even worse; for do not almost all of them perish from an inner lack of discipline? They are no longer tyrannized from the outside by the absolute value tablets of a church or a court: so they no longer learn to nurture their “inner tyrant,” their will. And what is true of artists is true in a higher and more fateful sense of philosophers. After all, where are the free spirits today? Just show me a free spirit today!?? — Well, let’s not talk too loudly! Solitude today is full of secrets and more solitude than ever. — — Indeed, I learned in the meantime that the free spirit has to be a hermit. 3715]? Another demagogical talent of our time is Richard Wagner: but he belongs in Germany. — Really? Let an opposing estimation have a chance to speak for once. The Parisians may block and bristle against Wagner as much as they want: in the end he belongs more in Paris than to G(ermany), and in any case more in it than in any other capital of Europe. Admittedly, the kind of French who are most closely related to him might have become scarce even there: — I mean those offspring of the romantisme” of the thirties, among whom he wanted to live in [Page 159] 152 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS the most decisive period of his life. There he felt more related to and at home with himself than in Germany, with his tremendous appetite for exotic smells and colors and untested new excesses of the sublime, with his sunless, tortured happiness in the discovery of the ugly and the horrific. What else did these romantics seek, what else did they find and invent‘ besides Richard Wagner? Were they not all intelligently sick like him, violent and unsure of themselves, dominated by literature up to their eyes and ears, most of them even writers, poets, artists of expression at any cost — I make an exception for Delacroix — mediators and collectors of the arts and the senses themselves, jumped-up plebeians who, like Balzac, showed (themselves) to be insatiable in their longing to shine and for fame and incapable of a noble tempo in living and creating — of a *lento* —? We should just admit it to ourselves: how much Wagnerian there is indeed to this French romanticism! Even that hysterical-erotic feature that Wagner especially loved in woman and set to music is best at home precisely in Paris: just ask the psychiatrists — ; and among the women of Paris, better than anywhere else, there is “appreciation” for the hy pnotizing tricks and laying-on of hands with which our musical magus and Cagliostro compels and persuades his little women to lustful sleep-walking with open eyes and closed minds. The proximity of pathological desires, the ardor of senses gone raving mad, where one’s gaze is deceived in a dangerous way by mists and veils of the supersensual: where does this belong more than in the romanticism of the French soul! Here a magic is at work that will yet inevitably convert even the Parisians to Wagner. — But Wagner is supposed to be the

thoroughly German artist: thus it is decreed today in Germany, thus he is venerated in a time that once again elevates boastful Teutomania. This “genuine German” Wagner does not exist at all: I suspect he is the spawn of very dark German youths and virgins who want to glorify themselves with this decree. It is probable enough that something in Wagner might be German: but what? Perhaps only the degree, not the quality of his willing and talents? [Page 16] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 9 34139] Bentham and utilitarianism depend on Helvétius — he is the last great event in morality. In German philosophy (Kant Schopenhauer) it is still “duty” or “instinct of compassion” — the old problems since Socrates (i.e., stoicism or Christianity, aristocracy of the individual or goodness of the herd) 34/40] I need a) someone to watch over my stomach b) someone who can laugh with me and has a boisterous spirit. c) someone who is proud of my company a(nd) “the other” also maintains the proper *façon*® of respect toward me d) someone who reads to me without dumbing down a book 34[41] *Plaire?* — the great secret of the French will, and at bottom of herd morality. “To have compassion,” altruism, are the Aypocritical expressions for it.*® 34142] NB. So far most artists (including the historians), even some of the greatest, belonged among the servants (whether of classes or princes or women or “masses”), not to mention their dependency on the Church and moral law. Thus Rubens produced portraits of the noble world of his time, but according to the taste it had in mind, not according to Ais standard of beauty — on the whole therefore against his taste. In this van Dyck was nobler: who added to all those whom he painted something of that which he valued most highly in himself: he did not step down, rather up to himself when he “reproduced” something. The slavish subservience of the artist before his public (as Sebastian Bach himself expresses it in immortally offensive words in [Page 160] 37 JUNE-JULY 1885 153 Perhaps only that he made everything stronger, richer, more daring, harsher than any Frenchman of the nineteenth century could make it? That he was more severe toward himself and for the longest part of his life he lived in the German way, on his own initiative as an implacable atheist, antinomist and immoralist? That he created the figure of a very free human being, of Siegfried, who in fact may be too free, too harsh, too cheerful, too unchristian for the Latin taste? — Of course in the end he knew how to make up for even this sin against French romanticism: the late W(agner) in his old age with his Siegfried-caricature, I mean with his Parsifal, accommodated not only Roman taste but downright Roman-Catholic taste: until ultimately he went so far as to genuflect before the cross and bid his farewell with a not ineloquent thirst for “the blood of the redeemer.” Farewell from himself too! For among romantics who have grown old there is an unpleasant rule that at the end of their life they “renounce” and disavow themselves and — cross out — their own life! — Finally let me ask: if that generation of the thirties in its blood and nerves was the heir and even more the

victim of those tragic convulsions of the Napoleonic period — Beethoven served as the prelude to this generation in sounds and Byron in words — is it not permitted to think of a similar lineage of the soul for Richard Wagner? He was born in 1813. 37[16] I observe that among those who now travel around in the world, no one likes to see himself regarded as a Frenchman if this is not what he is. To be considered an Englishman appears to be a source of pleasure for some northerners, e.g., the Swedes: the Englishman is proud. The German abroad now enjoys a boost of amazement and respect, compared to earlier times, but he is no pleasure; the Prussian in particular is still awkward in the southern countries of Europe, not because of his pride — for he is not proud — rather because of his immodesty and his bad, harsh, often obtrusive manners. The southern German is clumsy, peasant-like, good-natured and [Page 161] 154 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS yet not trust-inspiring: with him one senses the famous “two souls in one breast.”⁶ 37117”) One cannot think highly enough of women: but that is no reason to think falsely of them. In this one needs to be thoroughly on one’s guard. That they themselves would be in a position to enlighten men about “the eternal feminine” is improbable; perhaps they are too close to themselves for this — and moreover all this enlightening itself — at least up till now — has been a man’s affair and man’s skill. Finally one should reserve a good mistrust for everything that women write about woman: namely in case quite involuntarily a woman, even when she writes, ultimately must not do what — up till now at least — has been eternally feminine: namely “to dress up”! Has one ever conceded profundity to a female mind? And to a female heart — justice? But without profundity and justice — what good is it when women make judgments “about woman”! With love and praise even when one loves and praises oneself certainly the danger of being unjust and shallow is not lessened. Some women may have a good reason for thinking that men do not approach them with praise and love: taken as a whole it seems to me that up till now “woman” has been disrespected mostly by women — and absolutely not by man! 37118] A human being who strives for greatness regards everyone he encounters along the way either as a means or as a delay or as a temporary resting place. His unique and superior graciousness toward fellow human beings is only possible when he is at his height and dominating. Impatience and the feeling that up till now he has been condemned to comedy ruins every relationship for him: this kind of human being knows solitude and what is most poisonous in it. [Page 162] [38 = Mp XVI 1a. Mp XVI 2a. Mp XV 2b. June—July 1885] 3801] A thought in the shape in which it comes is an ambiguous sign that needs interpretation, more precisely, needs an arbitrary narrowing-down and limitation, until finally it becomes unambiguous. It surfaces in me — from where? through what? I do not know. It comes, independent of my willing, usually surrounded and obscured by a throng of feelings, desires, dislikes, also by other thoughts, often enough

scarcely distinguishable from a “willing” or “feeling.” One pulls it out of this throng, purifies it, stands it on its own feet, one sees how it stands there, how it walks, everything in an amazing presto’ and yet entirely without the feeling of haste: who does all this — I do not know and am certainly more of a spectator in this than originator of this process. Then one sits in judgment of the thought, one asks: “what does it mean? what can it mean? is it right or wrong?” — one summons the help of other thoughts, one compares it. Thinking proves in this manner to be nearly a kind of practice and act of justice in which there is a judge, an opposing party, even an interrogation of witnesses, to which I am allowed to listen a bit — to be sure only a bit: most of it, it seems, escapes me. — That every thought first comes ambiguously and floating and in itself only as the occasion for the attempt of interpretation or for arbitrary determination, that with all thinking a multiplicity of persons seems to be involved — : this is not at all so easy to observe, we are at bottom trained for the opposite, [Page 163] 156 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS namely not to think of thinking while thinking. The origin of the thought remains hidden; the probability is great that it is only the symptom of a much more comprehensive state; insofar as precisely it comes and no other, that precisely it comes with this greater or lesser clarity, sometimes confident and commanding, sometimes weak and in need of a prop, on the whole always exciting, questioning — for consciousness namely every thought functions like a stimulus — : in all of this something of our total state expresses itself in signs. — The same can be said of every feeling, it does not mean something in itself: when it comes it is first interpreted by us and often ow strangely interpreted! Just think of the urgency of the bowels that is almost “unconscious” to us, of the blood pressure strains of our lower body, of the pathological states of the nervus sympathicus? — and how much is there of which we scarcely have a shimmer of consciousness through our sensorium commune! — In the case of such uncertain feelings of aversion only someone trained in anatomy guesses the correct species and region of causes; but all others, therefore on the whole nearly all people, as long as people have existed, do not seek a physical, but rather a psychical and moral explanation for pains of this kind and foist a false justification on the actual irritations of the body, in that within the vicinity of their unpleasant experiences and tribulations they seize upon a reason to feel as badly as they do. Under torture nearly everyone confesses guilt; with pain whose physical cause one does not know, the tortured one questions himself so long and so inquisitorially until he himself or others are found guilty. — as was done by the Puritan for instance, who habitually gave moral interpretations to a spleen that is associated with an unreasonable life style, namely as the bite of his own conscience. — 38[2] The logical thinking of which logic speaks, a thinking where the thought itself is posited as the cause of new thoughts — is the model of a complete fiction: a thinking of this kind never

occurs in reality, but it is applied as a schema of forms and [Page 164] 38 JUNE-JULY 1885 157 filtering apparatus, with the help of which we dilute and simplify thinking's actual, extremely manifold occurrence: so that in this form our thinking becomes comprehensible, noticeable, communicable in signs. Therefore: to regard mental occurrence as if it really corresponded to that regulative scheme of a feigned thinking, this is the trick of falsification by virtue of which something like "knowledge" and "experience" exists. Experience is only possible with the help of memory; memory is only possible by means of an abbreviation of a mental process to a sign. "Knowledge": this is the expression of a new thing through the signs of already "known," already experienced things. —Today of course people even drivel about an empirical origin of logic: but what does not exist in reality, like logical thinking, cannot be derived from reality either, no more than some law of numbers as long as there has not yet been a case in which reality coincided with a mathematical formula. The mathematical formulas are likewise only regulative fictions with which we simplify and adjust real occurrence, for the purpose of practical exploitation, to our standard — to our stupidity —. 38[3]* — — — through thinking the ego is posited; but hitherto one believed, like the common people, that "I think" was some kind of immediate certainty, and this "I" was the given cause of thinking, according to whose analogy we understood all remaining causal relationships. However highly accustomed and indispensable that fiction may now be — This alone does not yet prove anything against its fictionality: a belief can be a condition of life and nevertheless be false. 38[4]° "Truth": within my way of thinking this describes not necessarily an opposition to error, but in the fundamental cases only a disposition of different errors to one another: perhaps that the one is older, deeper than the other, perhaps even inextinguishable, insofar as an organic being of our kind could not [Page 165] 158 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS live without it; while other errors do not tyrannize us to this extent as conditions of life, rather, measured against such "tyrants," can be set aside and "refuted." An assumption that is irrefutable — why must it on this account already be true? This proposition probably outrages the logicians, who posit their limits as the limits of things: but I declared war on this logician-optimism long ago. 38[5]° Even now France is still the seat of the most spiritual and sophisticated culture in Europe and the preeminent school of taste: but one has to know where to find this "France of taste." Whoever belongs to it keeps himself well hidden: a dumbeddown and coarsened France wallows in the foreground today — recently at the funeral of Victor H(ugo) it celebrated a veritable orgy of bad taste — they may be few in number, and include people who do not stand on the strongest of legs, some of them fatalists, some pampered (those who have reasons to hide themselves) — they as a whole recognize roughly the following higher spirits as their forefathers and masters. First Stendhal, the last great event of the French

spirit, who marched through his undiscovered Europe with a Nap(oleonic) tempo and ultimately found himself alone — horrifyingly alone: for it took two generations to even come close to him. Now he commands, as I said, a commander for the most elite; and whoever is gifted with subtle and daring senses, curious to the point of cynicism, a logician nearly from disgust, riddle guesser and friend of the sphinx like every born European, he will have to follow in his steps. May he also follow him to that place, full of shame for the secrets that great passion has when it stands still! This noblesse of being able to be silent, being able to stand still is his advantage for instance over Michelet and especially over German scholars. — His disciple is Mérimée, a noble withdrawn artist and despiser of those spongy emotions praised by a democratic age as its “noblest emotions,” austere toward himself and full of the harshest demands on his artistic logic, constantly prepared to [Page 166] 38 JUNE-JULY 1885 159 sacrifice small beauties and impulses to a strong will to necessity: — a genuine although not rich soul in a fake and dirty environment, pessimist enough to play along with the comedy without vomiting. — Another disciple of Stendhal is Taine, now the foremost living historian in Europe, a decisive, brave human being even in his despair, whose courage did not fall to pieces any more than did his will power under the fatalistic pressure of knowing, a thinker not diminished either by Condillac with respect to profundity nor Hegel with respect to clarity, rather someone who knew how to learn and for a long time will know how to teach: — the French of succeeding generations will have their spiritual drill sergeant in him. It is he primarily who pushes back the influence of Renan and Sainte-Beuve, who are both insecure and skeptical down to the bottom of their hearts: Renan, a kind of Catholic Schleiermacher, cloying, candy, feigning sensitivity for landscapes and religions: Sainte-Beuve, a burned-out poet who devotes himself to sniffing out souls and all too gladly would like to hide that he has no foothold either in the will or in philosophy, indeed, not surprisingly after both of these, he lacks a genuine solid taste in *artibus et litteris*.’ In the end one notices in him the intention of even turning this lack into a kind of principle and method of critical neutrality: but his annoyance betrays itself too often, at one point because he in fact was not neutral, but instead really enthused a few times about certain books and human beings — he would like to strike out and lie away these terrible “*petit faits*” from his life — but then because of the much more unpleasant *grand fait*? that all great French connoisseurs of humanity also genuinely possessed their own will and character, from Montaigne, Charon, La Rochefoucauld up to Chamfort and Stendhal: — compared to all of them Sainte-Beuve is not without envy and in any case without preference or preunderstanding. — Much more benevolent, one-sided, more able in every sense is the influence of Flaubert: with his preponderance of character that even endured solitude and failure — something extraordinary among French people — he rules at [Page 167] 160

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS the moment in the realm of the aesthetics of the novel and of style — he brought resounding and colorful French to the pinnacle. Of course he too lacks philosophical discipline, like Renan and Sainte-Beuve, likewise a genuine knowledge of scientific procedures: but in him a deep need for analysis and even for scholarliness along with an instinctive pessimism paved the way, oddly perhaps, but strongly enough to provide a model for the current novel writers of France. In fact the new ambition of the most recent school goes back to Flaubert, namely that of displaying themselves in scientific and pessimistic attitudes. — Whatever blossoms now in France by way of poets stands under the influence of Heinrich Heine and Baudelaire, perhaps with the exception of Leconte de Lisle: for in the same manner as Schopenhauer is now already loved and read more in France than in Germany, the cult of Heinrich Heine has relocated to Paris. As concerns the pessimistic Baudelaire, he belongs to those scarcely believable amphibians who are just as German as Parisian; his poetry has something of what in Germany is called *Gemiit!*® or “endless melody” and sometimes also “caterwauling.””! For the rest Baudelaire was a human being of perhaps ruined but very specific and sharp taste, sure of itself: with this he tyrannizes the insecure of today. Though in his day he was the first prophet and advocate of Delacroix: perhaps today he would be the first “Wagnerian” of Paris. There is much Wagner in Baudelaire. 38[6]!? Victor Hugo, an “ass of a genius” — the expression is from Baudelaire — who always had the courage of his bad taste: with it he knew how to command, he, the son of a Napoleonic general. In his ears he had the requirements of a kind of military rhetoric, he imitated in words the firing of cannons and the bursting of rockets; the French *esprit*!? appears in him obscured by smoke and din, so to speak, often to the point of naked stupidity. Never has a mortal written such dull, bursting antitheses. At other times he even gives the painter’s visual desires [Page 168] 38 JUNE-JULY 1885 161 mastery over his intellect: he bristles with picturesque insights and often does nothing more than to accurately copy what he sees, what the painter’s hallucination places in front of his eyes. He, the plebeian, who with his strong sensual desires, I mean his ears and eyes, does the will’s bidding even with his intellect — This after all is the basic fact of French *romantisme*, as a plebeian reaction of taste — : with this he is on the opposite track and wants precisely the inverse of what the poets of a noble culture wanted of themselves, for instance Corneille. For these had their pleasure and ambition in overwhelming their perhaps more strongly natured senses with the concept and in helping a subtle bright spirituality to victory against the brutal demands of colors, sounds and shapes: with which, it seems to me, they were on the trail of the great Greeks, despite how little they might have known about it. Precisely that which today causes us to be displeased about the ancient Greeks and the older French, offending our clumsy sensual and naturalistic taste — was the

purpose of their artistic willing, also their triumph: for they fought against and conquered precisely this “sensual rabble” whom our poets, painters and musicians aspire to help to some form of art. Victor Hugo’s political and moral designs correspond to this artistic one: he is shallow and demagogical, on his belly before all big words and gestures, a flatterer of the people who speaks with the voice of an evangelist to all lowly, oppressed, deformed, crippled people and does not have a whiff of what discipline and honesty of the spirit are, what intellectual conscience is — on the whole an unconscious actor, like nearly all artists of the democratic movement. His genius affects the masses as does an alcoholic drink that simultaneously makes one drunk and stupid. — The same species of sympathies and antipathies and something similar by way of talent were possessed by another advocate of the people, the historian Michelet, only in place of painter’s eyes an admirable capacity to reproduce states of mind within himself, in the manner of musicians: — today in obscure G(ermany) we would therefore refer to him as a human being of compassion. [Page 169] 162

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS This “compassion” in any case is something obtrusive; in his interactions and even in his veneration of past human beings there is much immodesty, indeed it sometimes seems to me as if he takes to his emotional work with a zeal that requires him to remove his coat. His eyes do not see into the depths: all easily “inspired” spirits were superficial so far. He is too excited for me: justice is just as inaccessible to him as that graciousness that only flows from the highest superiority. At a certain elevation of excitement he is overcome each time by an attack of the tribunes, he also knows from his own experience the rabble’s predatory fits of rage. It sufficiently characterizes the ignobility of his morality that Napoleon as well as Montaigne is foreign to him.”

It is unusual that even he, the industrious straightlaced scholar, richly shares in the sexually lascivious curiosity of his race: and the older he got, the more this kind of curiosity grew. — Finally, democratic and therefore likewise thespian is the talent of George Sand: she is eloquent in that wicked manner whereby her style, a colorful, unbridled exaggerating female style, runs away with her emotions every half page — not the opposite, as much as she wishes that people believe the opposite of her. Indeed, people believed much too much in her feeling: whereas she was rich in that cold skill of the actor who knows how to spare his nerves and makes everyone believe the opposite. One should concede that she has a great talent for narrating; but she ruined everything and forever with her heated female coquetry of showing herself only in men’s roles that did not suit precisely her height — her spirit was short-legged — : so that her books were taken seriously only for a brief time and already today have fallen into the realm of involuntarily comical literature. And if it was not only coquetry but cleverness as well that drove her to always drape herself in men’s problems and masculine appurtenances, including pants and cigars: ultimately the very female

problem and misfortune of her life nevertheless leaps into view, namely that she needed too many men and that even in these demands her senses and her spirit were divided. What could she do about the fact that whenever [Page 17] IO UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS the dedication to his High Mass”) is perhaps harder to recognize in music, but it is lodged all the deeper and more thoroughly in it. If I were to communicate my observations on this, one would not be able to tolerate listening to me. 34[43]° NB. The slow emergence and rise of the middle and lower classes (including the lower kind of spirit and body), which precluded abundantly already before the French Revolution and in any case would have moved forward without revolution, on the whole then the preponderance of the herd over all shepherds and bellwethers brings with it 1) A dimming of the spirit: The coexistence of a stoic and frivolous appearance of happiness as it belongs to noble cultures decreases: much suffering is allowed to be seen and heard which earlier was tolerated and concealed. 2) moral hypocrisy, a manner of wanting to distinguish oneself morally, but through herd virtues compassion welfare good deeds, which tend not to be acknowledged and respected outside the herd capacity 3) the real great quantity of compassion and shared joy, enjoyment of large-scale socializing as all herds have it — “common purpose,” “fatherland,” everything in which the individual does not come into consideration 34/44] In Goethe’s judgment Diderot showed himself to be truly German (Saint Ogan, p. 248)?! in everything that the French reproached. But the Neapolitans according to Galiani* also accepted his taste completely. 34145] Baudelaire, of German taste if ever a Parisian could have it, perceives things like a German when he does not tolerate Victor Hugo and calls him an “ass of a genius.” 3 [Page 170] 38 JUNE-JULY 1885 163 her spirit found pleasure in men, they were too sickly to satisfy the needs of her senses? Hence the eternal problem of two lovers at the same time and an eternal coercion of female modesty to deceive about this circumstance and to pretend that entirely different, much more general, much more impersonal problems stood in the foreground for her. For instance the problem of marriage: but what did she care about marriage! 38[7]”° People everywhere now are making an effort to divert attention from the actual great influence Kant exerted on German philosophy — and especially to wisely sidestep the value he attributed to himself. Kant was above all and chiefly proud of his table of categories, saying with this table in his hands: “this is the most difficult task that could ever be undertaken for the benefit of metaphysics”!® (let us make sure we understand this “could be”!) — he was proud of having discovered a new faculty in human beings, the faculty for synthetic judgments a priori. It does not concern us here how greatly he deceived himself about this: but German philosophy, as it has been admired and as it has influenced people throughout Europe for a hundred years, depended on this pride and on the rivalry of the younger generation to possibly discover something even prouder — and in any case new

faculties! It has so far constituted the actual fame of German philosophy that through it people were taught to believe in a kind of “intuitive and instinctive comprehension of truth”; and Schopenhauer too, as much as he scorned Fichte, Hegel and Schelling, was at bottom on the same course when he discovered in an old, well-known faculty, the will, that it had a new faculty — namely to be the very “thing in itself” This required one to reach in boldly indeed, and not spare one’s fingers, right into the “essence”! Bad enough that this essence turned out to be unpleasant, and, as a result of burned fingers, pessimism and denial of the will appeared to be absolutely necessary for living! But this fate of Schopenhauer is an incident that remained [Page 171] 164 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS without influence for the overall significance of German philosophy, for its higher “effect”: in the main namely it signified throughout Europe the jubilating reaction against the rationalism of Descartes and against the skepticism of the English, in favor of the “intuitive,” “instinctive,” and everything “good, true and beautiful.” One thought the way to knowledge was henceforth abbreviated, one could get directly to the heart of “things,” one hoped “to save labor”: and all the happiness that noble idlers, the virtuous, dreamers, mystics, artists, threefourths-Christians, political obscurantists and metaphysical concept-spiders are capable of perceiving accrued to the honor of Germans. The good reputation of Germans was suddenly manufactured: by their philosophers! — I hope people still know that in fact the Germans in Europe had a bad reputation? That people took them to have servile and pitiful qualities, an inability to have “character,” a famous servant-soul? All of a sudden, however, they learned to say: “the Germans are profound, the Germans are virtuous — just read their philosophers”! In the last analysis it was the suppressed and long obstructed piety of the Germans that finally exploded in their philosophy, unclear and uncertain, to be sure, like all things German, namely now in pantheistic vapors, as in Hegel and Schelling, as gnosis, now mystically and life-negating, as in Schopenhauer: in the main however a Christian piety, and not a pagan one — toward which Goethe and before him Spinoza had shown so much good will. 38[8]7 The will. — In every willing there is a plurality of sensations, namely the sensation of the state away from which, the sensation of the state toward which, the sensation itself of this “away” and “toward,” the sensation of duration, finally then an accompanying sensation in the muscles that comes into play through a kind of habit as soon as we “will,” even without our having to move our arms and legs. Secondly therefore, just as sensation and in fact many kinds of sensations are to be [Page 172] 38 JUNE-JULY 1885 165 recognized as ingredients of the will, so too thinking: in every act of will there is a commanding thought — and we had better not believe that this thought can be separated from the “willing” as if will would still be left over. Thirdly the will is not only a complex of sensation and thinking, but above all an affect: and specifically that affect of command. What we call

“freedom of the will” is essentially the affect of superiority with respect to the one who must obey: “I am free, he must obey” — this consciousness lies in every will, and likewise that straining of attention, that clear gaze that fixes on one thing exclusively, that unconditional valuation “now this is essential and nothing else,” that inner certainty that something will be obeyed, as all this belongs to the disposition of the commander. Someone who wills — commands something in himself that obeys or which he believes obeys. But now let us observe what is the most wondrous thing about the “will,” about this very complicated thing for which the people have only one word: insofar as in this case we are simultaneously the commanders and the obeyers, and as obeyers we know the sensations of resisting, pushing, pressing, moving, which usually begin immediately after the act of willing; and insofar on the other hand as we have a habit of disregarding and deceiving ourselves about this duality by virtue of the synthetic concept “I,” a whole chain of erroneous conclusions and consequently of false valuations has attached itself to willing: — to such an extent that the willing individual believes in good faith that his will itself is the actual and sufficient mobile? for the entire action. And because in most cases by far there has only been willing where the effect of command, of obedience, therefore action could be expected, the appearance has translated into sensation, as if there were a necessity of effect there: enough, someone who wills believes with a considerable degree of certainty that will and action are somehow one — he attributes the success of executing the will to the will itself and in doing so enjoys an increase in that feeling of power that comes with all commanding. “Freedom of the will”: that is the word for [Page 173] 166 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS that very mixed state of the one who wills, who commands and simultaneously as the executor also enjoys the triumph of superiority over obstacles, but thinks to himself that it is his will alone that really overcomes the obstacles: — he takes the pleasurable sensations of the executing successful tool — the useful will and sub-will — and adds them to his pleasurable sensation as commander. — This interwoven nest of sensations, states and false assumptions, which is described by the people with one word and as one thing because it is suddenly and all “at once” there and belongs among the most frequent, consequently the “best known” experiences: the will as I have described it here — can we believe that it has never before been described? That this clumsy prejudice of the people so far has rightfully existed untested in every philosophy? That there was no difference of opinion among philosophers regarding what “willing” is, because they all believed that precisely here one had an immediate certainty, a fundamental fact, here opining was not at all in order? And that all logicians still teach the trinity “thinking, feeling, willing” as if “willing” included no feeling and thinking? — After all of this Schopenhauer’s major blunder seems less crazy and arbitrary, when he took the will as the best-known thing in the

world, indeed as the actual and solely known thing: he simply took over a tremendous prejudice of all previous philosophers, a popular prejudice, and as philosophers generally do, exaggerated it. — 38[9] There is no small danger in extraordinary spirits that at some time they will learn to strive for the horrific pleasures of destroying, of ruining, of slowly ruining: namely when they are absolutely denied the creative deed, perhaps through a lack of tools or some other mischief of chance. In the economy of such souls there is no longer an either-or; and perhaps they must (corrupt), with the pleasure of a devil and in a subtle protracted manner, precisely what they have loved most up till then. [Page 174] 38 JUNE-JULY 1885 167 38[r] The human being is a form- and rhythm-constructing creature; in nothing is he better practiced and it appears that he takes pleasure in nothing more than in the inventing of shapes. Just observe what our eye immediately becomes occupied with as soon as it no longer gets to see anything: it creates itself something to see. Presumably in the same case our hearing does no differently: it practices. Without the transformation of the world into shapes and rhythms there would be no “sameness” for us, therefore nothing recurring, therefore also no possibility for experience and appropriation, for nourishment. In all perceiving, that is, in the most original appropriation, the essential occurrence is a doing, or better yet: an imposition of forms: — only the superficial speak of “impressions.” Human beings get to know their force here as a resisting and even more as a determining force — rejecting, selecting, forming to suit, arranging into their schemata. There is something active in the fact that we even adopt a stimulus and that we adopt it as such a stimulus. It is characteristic of this activity not only to posit forms, rhythms and series of forms, but also to evaluate the created formation with respect to incorporation or rejection. Thus our world emerges, our entire world: and this world that belongs to us alone, first created by us corresponds to no alleged “actual reality,” no “in-itself of things”: instead, it is itself our sole reality, and “knowledge” turns out to be, regarded in this manner, only a means of nourishment. But we are hard-to-nourish beings and have enemies everywhere and indigestible things, as it were — : this is why human knowledge has become refined and ultimately so proud of its refinement that it does not like to hear it is not a goal, but a means or even a tool of the stomach — if not a kind of stomach itself! — — 38(11)!° The superior philosophical human being, who has solitude around himself, not because he wants to be alone but because [Page 175] 168 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS he é s something that does not find his equal: what dangers and new sufferings are reserved just for him today, when one has unlearned belief in order of rank and consequently does not know how to honor and understand this solitude! Formerly a wise man almost sanctified himself for the conscience of the masses through such stepping-aside — today the hermit sees himself as if surrounded by a cloud of gloomy doubt and suspicions. And not only perhaps on

the part of the envious and the pitiful: he has to perceive misjudgment, neglect and superficiality emanating from every benevolence that he experiences, he knows those treacheries of narrow compassion that feels itself to be good and holy when it seeks to “rescue” him from himself, perhaps through more comfortable circumstances, through more orderly, more trustworthy company — indeed, he will have to marvel at the unconscious drive to destruction with which all mediocre of spirit are active against him, and what is more, in the best belief in their right to it! It is necessary for humans of this incomprehensible solitude to wrap themselves skillfully and heartily even in the mantle of external, of spatial solitude: this belongs to their prudence. Even cunning and disguise will be needed today for such a human being to sustain himself, to hold himself up amidst the sweeping, dangerous rapids of the times. For every attempt to endure it in the present, with the present, for every approach to these human beings and goals of today he must do penance as if for an actual sin: and he might marvel at the hidden wisdom of his nature, which always immediately called him back to himself after all such temptations through sickness and wicked accidents.

38[12]”° And do you also know what “the world” is to me? Should I show it to you in my mirror? This world: a colossus of energy, without beginning, without end, a firm, unshakable magnitude of energy that does not get bigger, does not get smaller, that does not expend itself but only transforms itself, as a whole [Page 176] 38 JUNE-JULY 1885 169 unchangeable in size, an economy without expenditures and losses, but likewise without growth, without income, encased by “nothingness” as by its border, nothing blurring, wasted, nothing infinitely extended, but laid into a definite space as a definite force, and not a space that would be “empty” anywhere, rather as force everywhere, as play of forces and waves of forces simultaneously one and “multiple,” increasing itself here and at the same time decreasing itself there, a sea of forces storming and flooding together, eternally transforming, eternally receding, with tremendous years of return, with an ebb and flow of its configurations, from the simplest striving outward into the most complex, from the stillest, most rigid, coldest out into the most glowing, wildest, most self-contradictory, and then returning home again from abundance to the simple, from the play of contradictions returning to the joy of accord, affirming itself even in this sameness of its courses and years, blessing itself as that which must recur eternally, as a becoming that knows no satiety, no tedium, no weariness — : this my Dionysian world of eternal self-creating, of eternal self-destroying, this mystery-world of the doubly voluptuous, this my beyond good and evil, without goal, if a goal does not lie in the happiness of the circle, without will, if a ring does not have good will for itself — do you want a name for this world? A solution for all its riddles? a Light for you too, you hiddenmost, strongest, most intrepid, most midnightly? — This world is the will to power — and nothing else! And you yourselves are also this

will to power — and nothing else!”! 38 [13]? When I was younger I worried about just what a philosopher actually is: for I believed I perceived contradictory features in the famous philosophers. Finally it occurred to me that there are two different kinds of philosopher, first those who have to hold on to some great factual legacy of valuations, that is previous valuations and value creations (logical or moral), then those who themselves are legislators of valuations. The former seek to [Page 177] 170 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS master the present or past world by summarizing and abbreviating it through symbols. It is the duty of these researchers to make all previous events and everything that has been valued so far surveyable, thinkable, comprehensible, handy, to overpower the past, to abbreviate everything that is long, indeed time itself, a great and wonderful task. The actual philosophers however are commanders and legislators, they say: it shall be so! they alone determine the where-to and what-for of human beings and in so doing dispose of the preliminary work of the philosophical laborers, those who overpower the past. This second kind of philosopher rarely turns out well; and in fact their situation and danger are tremendous. How often have they purposely blindfolded themselves, in order simply not to have to see anymore the narrow ledge that separates them from abyss and plunge: for instance Plato, when he convinced himself that the good as he wanted it was not Plato’s good, but the good in itself; the eternal treasure that some human being named Plato happened to find along his way! This same will to blindness reigns in a much cruder form in the founders of religion: their “thou shalt” must absolutely not sound like “I want” to their ears — only as the command of a god do they dare to comply with their task, only as “inspiration” is their legislation of values a bearable burden under which their conscience does not shatter. — Now as soon as those two consolations, those of Plato and Mohammed, have fallen away and no thinker can ease his conscience anymore with the hypothesis of a “god” or “eternal values,” the claim of the legislator’s new values rises to a new and never before attained level of terribleness. From now on those hand-picked ones on whom the inkling of such a duty begins to dawn will make the attempt to see whether they might be able to escape it at just “the right time,” as their greatest danger, through some kind of leap to the side: for instance, by convincing themselves that the task has already been solved, or it is unsolvable, or they do not possess the shoulders for such burdens, or they are already overburdened with other more immediate tasks, or even this new distant duty is a seduction [Page 178] 38 JUNE-JULY 1885 II and temptation, a distraction from all duties, a sickness, a kind of madness. Some may indeed succeed in evading it: the trace of such evaders and their bad conscience runs through the whole of history. But for the most part that redeeming hour came for these fateful human beings, that autumn hour of ripeness when they had to do what they did not even “want” to do: — and the deed they previously feared

more than anything fell to them easily and unbidden from the tree, as a deed without arbitrariness, almost as a gift. — 38[14] What separates us most thoroughly from all Platonic and Leibnizian ways of thinking is: we do not believe in any eternal concepts, eternal values, eternal forms, eternal souls; and philosophy, insofar as it is science and not legislation, for us means only the broadest extension of the concept “history.” On the basis of etymology and the history of language we take all concepts as having become, many as still becoming; moreover in such a way that the most universal concepts, as the *fa/* *sest*, must also be the oldest. “Being,” “substance,” and “absolute,” “sameness,” “thing” — : thinking invented these schemata, which in fact most thoroughly contradicted the world of becoming, as the first and the oldest, but which appeared from the start to correspond with it, given the dullness and monotony of the incipient, still sub-animal consciousness: every “experience” seemed always to underscore it anew and underscore it entirely alone. Sameness and similarity were admitted ever more rarely with the sharpening of the senses and of attention, with the development and the struggle of the most manifold life: whereas for the lowest beings everything seemed “eternally the same,” “one,” “permanent,” “absolute,” “without qualities.” Eventually the “external world” multiplied itself in this way; but through tremendous stretches of time a thing on earth was considered identical and corresponding with a single characteristic, for example with a certain color. The multiplicity of characteristics of a single thing was admitted only with the greatest [Page 179] 172 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS slowness: we still see a resistance against the multiplicity of predicates in the history of human language. But the longest confusion is that the predicate symbol is posited as equal to the thing itself; and the philosophers, who have best reproduced in themselves precisely the oldest instincts of humanity and also the oldest fears and superstitions (like the superstition of the soul) — one can speak of an atavism par excellence in them — pressed their seal upon this confusion when they taught that precisely the symbols, namely the “ideas” were what truly existed, what was unchanging and all-valid. Whereas in fact, in the perception of a thing, thinking navigates a series of symbols offered to him by memory, and looks for similarities; whereas a human being with a similar symbol posits, grasps, apprehends the thing as “known”: for a long time he simply believed he comprehended it in this manner. Seizing and grasping, appropriating already meant knowing for him, a knowing-to-the-end; for a long time even the words in human language seemed — and today still seem to the common people — to be not symbols but truths with respect to the things they signify. The more refined the senses, the more rigorous the attention, the more manifold the tasks of life became, the harder it was to admit the knowledge of a thing, of a fact, as definitive knowledge, as “truth”; and in the very end, at the point to which our methodical mistrust has driven us today, we no longer give ourselves the right at

all to speak of truths in the absolute sense — we have sworn off the belief in the knowability of things just as much as the belief in knowledge. The “thing” is only a fiction, the “thing in itself” even a contradictory unpermitted fiction: but knowing, too, of the absolute and consequently also the relative kind, is likewise only a fiction! With this, the necessity also disappears for positing a something that “knows,” a subject for knowing, some pure “intelligence,” an “absolute spirit”: — this mythology not yet completely given up by Kant, which Plato prepared for Europe in a disastrous manner and which, using the fundamental Christian dogma of “God is a [Page 18] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 II 34[46] If I have something of a unity in me then it certainly does not lie in the conscious ego and in feeling, willing, thinking, but somewhere else: in the preserving, appropriating, distinguishing, surveilling prudence of my entire organism, of which my conscious ego is only a tool. — Feeling willing thinking everywhere reveal only end phenomena whose causes are entirely unknown to us: the succession of these end phenomena as if one resulted from the other is probably only an illusion: in truth the causes might possibly be bound to one another in such a way that the end-causes give me only the impression of logical or psychological binding. 7 deny that a spiritual or psychic phenomenon is the direct cause of another spiritual or psychic phenomenon: even though it appears so. The true world of causes is hidden from us: it is unspeakably more complicated. The intellect and the senses are above all a simplifying apparatus. But our false, miniaturized, logicized world of causes is the world in which we are able to live. We are “knowing” to the extent that we can satisfy our needs. The study of the body offers a sense of the unspeakable complications. If our intellect did not have a few firm forms, then it would be impossible to live. But this proves nothing for the truth of all logical facts. 34147] The underhanded self-deprecation of Socrates, used to render his opponent unsuspecting and safe, so that he lets himself go and blurts straight out what he thinks: a trick of the rabble man! Logic was not at home in Athens. 34148] NB. A bit more brightness of mind and a bit of good will: and one no longer tolerates, for reasons of taste, interpreting his experiences to suit the “glory of God,” I mean seeing everywhere the traces of God’s solicitude, warning, punishment, instruction. Just [Page 180] 38 JUNE-JULY 1885 173 spirit,” threatened all science of the body and therewith also the continued development of the body with death — this mythology has now had its time. 38[15] I have experienced strange things with respect to the effect of my books. Recently I received the letter of an old noble Dutchman” who regards *Human, All Too Human* as his most faithful life companion; the *Birth of Tragedy* perhaps produced the greatest sound of happiness in the life of R(ichard) W(agner), he was beside himself, and there are wondrously beautiful things in the *Twilight of the Gods* that he produced in this state of an unexpected greatest hope. (Back then — — — I would like to know if

this book has been understood by anyone: its backgrounds belong to my most personal property. Zarathustra has the value estimations of a couple of millennia against it; I absolutely do not believe that anyone today is in a position to hear the ringing of its overall tone: understanding it also presupposes a kind of philological and more than philological work that no one today would invest in it, out of a lack of time. I myself am very satisfied with the fact that my taste in music and philosophic, which in 1865 (when I was perhaps the only German who, just as Schopenhauer and Wagner) and — — — now belongs to German taste. The choice that people make with respect to my books gives me food for thought. 38[16] the unhesitating use of stop-gaps and of spiritual expenditure and wealth in order to give a weakness here the attribute of strength: what nearly gives Wagnerian style its character — 38[17] Schopenhauer's perversity of mentality and my Birth of Tragedy! [Page 181] 174 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 38 [18] "he could have acted differently" — this viewpoint on the emergence of the sense of justice is falsely applied by Rée.²⁵ 38[19]° In surveying my life, the first trace of philosophical meditation that I can lay my hands on I encounter in a small text from my 13th year: it contains an insight concerning the origin of evil. My assumption was that for a God thinking something and creating something are one and the same. Now I reasoned thus: God thought himself at the time when he created the second person of the divinity: but in order to be able to think himself he first had to think his opposite. Thus in my representation the devil had the exact same age as the son of God, even a clearer origin — and the same descent. Regarding the question of whether it was possible for a God to think his opposite, I finessed this by saying: but everything is possible for him. And secondly: that he did it is a fact, in case the existence of a God-son is a fact, consequently it was also possible for him, — — — 38[20] Without a passionate pleasure in the adventures of knowledge someone will scarcely endure very long in its dangerous realm; and anyone who is too cowardly or too timid for such "dissipations" should in fairness acknowledge making a virtue and a commendation of it, too. But for the stronger spirits, the demand that one should indeed be a human being of passion, but also the master of his passions, also applies with respect to their passion for knowledge. Just as Napoleon, to the astonishment of Talleyrand, allowed his anger to bark and roar at the chosen time and then later, just as suddenly, silenced it, so too the strong spirit must do with his wild dogs: at the chosen time, no matter how urgent the will to truth is in him — it is his wildest dog — he must be able to be the incarnate will to [Page 182] 38 JUNE-JULY 1885 175 untruth, the will to uncertainty, the will to ignorance, above all to foolishness. 38[21] The decline of grace. — Belonging among the symptoms of general uglification as it accompanies an age that increasingly makes the rabble its master, not the least is the growing letting-herself-go of woman and a kind of "return to nature" i.e., to

the rabble: even in places where noble and rigorous habits were formerly maintained like a privilege: e.g., at court. One stands amazed before the lack of refinement even in dealings with the most amiable of women: and we help ourselves — — — 38[22] A garden in which even the lattice is gilded has to defend itself not only against thieves and rascals: its worst dangers are presented by its meddlesome admirers, who everywhere would like to break off something and all too gladly take away this or that as a memento. — And do you not notice, you idlers in my garden, that you cannot justify yourselves even next to my herbs and weeds, that they say to your face: be gone, you intruders, you — — — [Page 183] [39 = N VII 2a. Z I 2b. August-September 1885] 39[1]" The Will to Power. Attempt at a New Interpretation of All Events. By Friedrich Nietzsche. 392]? "milky spirit" Like a child encountering other people's public holidays: shyly it stands there — never before has it heard this bell, never before did it see these decorations and festive costumes. Am I then a mirror that becomes cloudy and blind right away because a stranger's breath breathes on me, seethes at me? Why do you want to scrape the down from such things? — Truths that no smile has gilded. 39[3]° Zarathustra 5 (youth as the basic tone) martial in the highest degree [Page 184] 39 AUGUST—SEPTEMBER 1885 177 Onan old fortress the drumming of heralds. (Finale) at night as on the Rialto.4 the rose festival. Zarathustra the godless hermit, the first solitary one who did not pray. Are you strong enough for my truths? Who belongs with me? what is noble? "Are you such?" (as refrain) the order of rank: and you must have everything in you in order to be able to rule, but also under you! Refrain: "a(nd) if you are not able to speak: "we honor them, yet we are of a superior kind" —then you are not of my kind. The rose festival. At night on the bridge. Zarathustra happy about the fact that the struggle of the classes is over and now finally it is time for an order of rank of individuals. Hatred for the democratic leveling-system is only in the foreground: actually he is very glad that this has gone so far. Now he can solve his task. — His teachings so far were directed only at the future ruling caste. These rulers of the earth are now supposed to replace God and create for themselves the profound unconditional confidence of the ruled. First: their new holiness, their renunciation of happiness and pleasure. They give the lowliest the prospect of happiness, not themselves. They redeem the misfits with the doctrine of the "quick death," they offer religions and systems according to the order of rank. 3914] The self-mirroring of the spirit, the creaking of the logical clockwork, the unwinding of the instincts Supposing you had resolved everything into formulas: what would happen then? Are we supposed to /ive with bad conscience? [Page 185] 178 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS I admire the great falsifications and interpretations: they elevate us above the happiness of animals. The overestimation of truthfulness in the circles of the herd animal makes good sense. To not allow oneself to be cheated — and consequently — to

not cheat. That the truthful one is of more value than the liar cannot be proved by anything; and supposing that life is based on a consequential being-deceived, then a consequ(ential) liar could achieve highest honors under certain circumstances. That one harms by not “telling the truth” is a naïveté. If the value of life lies in well-believed errors, what is harmful resides in “telling the truth.” 3915] Life in the hereafter gone? — the pointe’ of life has been taken away. 39[6]° Just as the matador fig’ pursues its goals, ruining that which it wants only as a support: so too reason in relation to the philos(ophers). What does every philosophy mean for the life of a human being? Whether as enhancement of the feeling of power: Or as a means of masking an unbearable existence? Behind consciousness the drives are working. 3917] Nourishment property reproduction sexual lust (as a narcotic work (overcoming of oscillations) The sublime human being has the highest value, even when he is quite delicate and fragile, because an abundance of quite difficult and rare things has been cultivated and kept together through many generations.® Primeval forest animals the Romans? 39[8] The deification of the devil — how did this heavenly illusion occur! [Page 186] 39 AUGUST—SEPTEMBER 1885 179 The belief in goodness justice and truth at the bottom of things has something hair-raising about it. The masks of the devil. 3919] The interpretation of nature: we interpret ourselves into it. — the terrible character. 3910}! Zarathustra 1. the beginnings of the differentiation. All “happiness” permitted only as cure or resting. Against the “happy” and “good” and the herd animals. Zarathustra 2. The “se/fovercoming” of the human being. Greatest of all struggles and longest cultivation. As a means the “tempters” are conjured up. Zarathustra 3 on the ring the primeval forest, everything in terrible magnification 39[11] In order not to express the opposite about the essence of the world, one must hold firm that every moment signifies a necessary total-displacement of all changes; but as a thinking and creating thing it must of course compare, consequently also be able to be timeless vis-à-vis its own inner conditions. 3912)“ Chap. Nourishment. Procreation. Adaptation. Traced back to will to power. Heredity. Division of labor. Chap. The juxtaposition of consciousness with that which actually drives and rules. [Page 187] 180 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS Chap. The reversal of the temporal order: also in embryonic growth (organic development reversed, as it is stored in memory: simultaneously the oldest as the strongest in front). Just as the oldest errors constitute the spine, so to speak, to which everything else attaches itself. Chap. The development of the logical 39[13]!° The qualities of the organic being. The development of organic beings. The union of the organic and the inorganic. “Knowledge” in relation to the conditions of life. The “perspectival.” “Laws of nature” as determination of power relations. “Cause and effect” an expression for the necessity and inexorability of this power determination. Freedom of the will and power. Pain and joy in relation to the will to power. “Person” “subject” as

deception. A ruled community. Using the body as a guide. Ruling and obeying as expression of the will to power, in the organic. Emergence of the logical. “Rationale.” Against self-mirroring. Mathem(atics). The physical world like the psychical both false, but enduring errors. The artist and the will to power. The impression of neutrality is mesmerizing for herd animals. Palazzo Pitti!? and Phidias. Art depending on morality, for herds or leaders: — — — the refutation of God, actually only the mor(al) God is refuted. Rights and duties. The punishments. Point of departure. Irony toward Descartes: supposing that at the bottom of things there were something deceitful from [Page 188] 39 AUGUST—SEPTEMBER 1885 181 which we derived, what would it help de omnibus dubitare!“ It could be the most beautiful means of deceiving ourselves. Moreover: is it possible? “Will to truth” as “I do not want to be cheated” or “I do not want to cheat” or “I want to convince myself and become firm,” as a form of the will to power. “Will to justice” “Will to beauty” all will to power. “Will to help” on goodness. 39[14])° For the preface. Human comprehension — which is ultimately always an interpretation according to us and our needs — stands in relation to the rank that the human being assumes in the order of all beings. Let it serve as an example, how much the finger knows what the piano player executes with it. It will sense nothing but mechanical processes and logically combine these. Even among humans the lowly exert their power without awareness of what purpose they serve in the big picture. The whole physical causality is interpretable in a hundred ways, according to whether a human or another being interprets it. — For cruder types of human being the Auman kind of goodness or justice or wisdom was verifiable from nature. Inasmuch as finer more spiritual human beings now reject this verifiability, they do it because their concept of goodness justice and wisdom has grown. Atheism is the result of an elevation of the human being: at bottom he has become more bashful, deeper and more modest before the fullness of the whole; he has better understood his order of rank. The farther our knowledge grows, the more the human being perceives himself in his corner. The most shameless and firmest articles of faith that we bear in us stem from the period of our greatest ignorance, e.g., that our will is cause etc. How naively we carry our moral valuations into things, e.g., when we speak of /aws of nature! It might be useful once to conduct [Page 189] 182 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS an experiment of a completely different manner of interpretation: so that through an embittered contradiction we come to understand how very unconsciously our moral canon (preference for truth, law, rationality etc.) reigns in our entire so-c(alled) science. Put popularly: God has been refuted, but not the devil: and all divine functions are also part of his nature: the opposite did not work! He deceives, he creates deceiving intellects He prefers to destroy He ruins insofar as he spurs the highest to ennoblement In the woods: he allows his innocence to be worshipped Ultimately: why do we hate such a

being? 39[t]° For the introduction. The great danger is not pessimism (a form of hedonism), the calculating of pleasure and pain,” and whether perhaps human life includes an excess of painful feelings. Instead, the meaninglessness of all events! The moral interpretation has become invalid at the same time as the religious interpretation: this they do not know of course, the superficial! The more impious they are, the more instinctively they cling with their teeth to moral valuations. Schopenhauer as atheist uttered a curse upon anyone who divests the world of its moral significance. In England they strive to associate morality with physics, Mister von Hartmann morality and the irrationality of existence. But the actual great fear is: the world no longer has a meaning To what extent the previous morality has also fallen away with “God”: they mutually supported one another. Now I bring a new interpretation, an “immoral” one, in relation to which our previous morality appears as a special case. Put popularly: God has been refuted, but not the devil. — 39[16] With the foolish and immodest question of whether pleasure or pain is preponderant in the world, one stands in the [Page 19] I UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS as a good philologist (and generally any philologically trained scholar) has an aversion to false textual interpretations (e.g., those of Protestant preachers in their pulpits — which is why the educated classes no longer go to church) —, likewise and not as a result of great “virtue,” “honesty” etc., the counterfeiting of religiously interpreting all experiences offends one’s taste. — 34149] Our pleasure in simplicity, surveyability, regularity, brightness, from which ultimately a German “philosopher” could extract something like a categorical imperative of logic and the beautiful — for this I confess that a strong instinct must be present. It is so strong that it reigns in all our sensual activities and reduces, regulates, assimilates etc. the abundance of real perceptions (the unconscious ones —) and first displays them to our consciousness in this contrived form. This “logical,” this “artistic” something is our continuous activity. What made this force so sovereign? Obvious that without it no living being could live on account of the chaos of impressions. 34150] (I do not see why the organic even had to originate at any point in time — —) 34151] In chemistry is revealed that every substance pushes its force as far as it can, then a third something emerges. The qualities of a child cannot be deduced from the most accurate knowledge of the father and the mother. For they are the effects of the third thing on us, these qualities: but the effects of the first and the effects of the second, i.e., their qualities are impossible to add as “effects of the third” 34152] The chain of causation is concealed from us: and the relationship and the sequence of effects only yields a succession: however [Page 190] 39 AUGUST— SEPTEMBER 1885 183 midst of philosophical dilettantism: such things should be left to yearning poets and little women. On a nearby planet there could be so much happiness and amusement that it would outweigh “the entire misery of humanity”!® ten times over: what do we know! And on the other hand we really

only want to be the inheritance of Christian profundity and sensitivity, so that we do not condemn suffering in itself: whoever no longer knows how to use it morally, for the “salvation of the soul,” is supposed to at least accept its aesthetic validity — be it as artist or observer of things. The world, suffering thought away, is unaesthetic in every sense: and perhaps pleasure is only a form and rhythmic variety of the same! I meant to say: perhaps suffering is something of what is essential to all existence. 39[17] One is permitted to hope that the human being will rise so high that the formerly highest things, e.g., the previous belief in God, will seem childlike-childish and touching, indeed that he will once again do as he has done with all myths, namely transform (them into) children’s stories and fairy tales. 39[18] NB. The credibility of the body first is the basis according to which the value of all thinking can be evaluated. Supposing we had thought nothing but things that do not exist! (as e.g., Teichmüller assumes!) etc. The body proves itself less and less to be illusion! Who until now has had reasons to think the body as illusion? The perfect Brahman-worshipper. 39[19] Woman And wherever a woman comes to be conscious of any kind of talent: how much ridiculous self-admiration, how much “goose” is unleashed each time at the same time! [Page 191] 184 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 39[20]” Jew. — I highlight with distinction Siegfried Lipiner, a Polish Jew who knows how to reproduce the most diverse forms of European lyric in the most delicate manner — “nearly genuine,” as a goldsmith would say — 39[21] Hellwald, *Natural History of Human Beings*. Hermann Miiller on plants. Burmeister 39[22]”^o Zarathustra 4. says to his own: watch out, whoever speaks against suffering, illusion, foolishness — he belongs to the common people, even as a philosopher. How does one best speak to the masses? I do not know, it does not belong to my task. It seems to me that one must make their lives very hard through the demands of strict virtues: otherwise they become lazy and voluptuous, also in their thinking. For the /ower human beings the opposite valuations apply: it is a matter of planting the virtues in them. The absolute commands, terrible tyrants, tear them away from the easy life”! the significance of religions Zarathustra as seducer of youth, the vengeance of the fathers, he commands them to wait. Zarathustra walking on the ramparts of the fortress: — he hears someone preaching absolute pessimism. The city is surrounded. He remains silent. [Page 192] [40 = W I 7a. August-September 1885] 4of] The weary, suffering, fearful mean peace, mean immovability, calm, something similar to deep sleep when they think of the supreme happiness. Much of this has gotten into philosophy. Likewise fear of the uncertain, ambiguous, changeable has brought to favor its opposite, the simple, what remains the same, the predictable, the certain. Another kind of being would bring the opposite conditions to favor. But as I, ten years ago — — — 4ol]’ The Will to Power. Attempt at a New Interpretation of all Events. (Preface on the threatening “meaninglessness.” Problem of pessimism.)

Logic. Physics. Morality. Art. Politics. 40[3]? For whom this interpretation is important. New “philosophers.” There might be someone here and there who loves his independence in a similar way — but we do not crowd together, we do not “long” for one another. [Page 193] 186 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

40[4] We are the heirs of the imperfect bad variety, the longest variety of observing and inferring. Our most thorough and incorporated concepts will probably be the falsest: namely to the extent that we have been able to live with them! But conversely one can ask: would life even be possible at all with a finer observation and a more rigorous cautious process of inference? Even today the practical portion of our life is still experimental in the crudest sense, hit-or-miss: just look at what most people know about nutrition! That the expediency of means in the overall history of organisms has increased (as Spencer believes) is an English-superficial judgment, in relation to the complexity of our aims the stupidity of means has probably stayed the same. 40[5] The increase of stealth in the order of rank of beings (in the inorganic power against power quite crudely, in the organic world cunning etc.) the highest human beings like Caesar Napoleon (Stendhal’s quote about him) likewise the higher races (Italians etc.). Should we not consider it possible that the most thousand-fold slyness belongs in the nature of higher creatures? Naturally the sense of truth (to see what is) would also have to increase, as a means of being able to appear. The actor. Dionysus.

40[6] How impoverished have the philosophers been so far when language, or at least grammar, on the whole that which is their inner “common people” has prompted? them! There are truths in words, at least inklings of truth: this is what they all believe rigidly and firmly: hence the tenacity with which they cling to “subject” “body” “soul” “spirit.” What disaster lies in the single mummified error concealed by the word “abstraction”! As if by omitting, and not on the contrary by underscoring, emphasizing, strengthening, we could give rise to that which is described [Page 194] 40 AUGUST —SEPTEMBER 1885 187 in such a manner! Just as every image, every form emerges in us and becomes possible, through coarsening! 40[7] Just as the emergence of arithmetic had to be preceded by a long practice and preschooling in seeing the same, in wanting to take things as the same, in positing identical cases and in “counting,” so likewise logical inference. Judgment is originally more than the belief “this and that is true,” rather “thus and such is precisely how I want it to be true!” The drive to assimilation, that organic basic function on which all growth is based, also adapts internally what it appropriates from its vicinity: the will to power functions in this comprising of the new under the forms of what is old, previously experienced, still alive in memory: and then we call it — “comprehending”!

40[8] The concept “individual” “person” contains a great relief for naturalistic thinking: which above all feels good when doing multiplication tables. In fact prejudices are found there: but unfortunately we do not have words to describe

what really exists, namely the degrees of intensity on the way to the individual, to the “person.” Two derive from one, one from two: this can be clearly seen in the procreation and propagation of the lowest organisms; mathematics is constantly contradicted in real events, counter/ived, if the expression is permitted. I once used the expression “many mortal souls”: ‘just as everyone has the stuff for many personas. 40[9] There are schematic minds, those who hold a thought-complex to be truer if it can be sketched into previously drafted schemata or categorical tables. There are countless self-deceptions in this area: nearly all great “systems” belong here. But the basic prejudice is: that order, surveyability, the systematic must cling to the true being of things, and conversely disorder, the chaotic, the unpredictable [Page 195] 188

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS come to the fore only in a false or imperfectly known world — in sum are errors — : — which is a moral prejudice, drawn from the fact that the truthful confidence-inspiring human being tends to be a man of order, of maxims, and on the whole something predictable and pedantic. Now it is however quite unverifiable that the in-itself of things comports with this recipe of a model bureaucrat. 40[10] — Descartes is not radical enough for me. With his craving for certainty and “I do not want to be deceived” one needed (to) ask “why not?” In sum, moral prejudices (or utilitarian justifications) in favor of certainty against appearance and uncertainty. It is in this context that I look at the philosophers, from the Vedanta philos(ophy) to the present: why this hatred for the untrue, evil, painful etc.? — For the preface. First take care of the mor(al) valuations! — For the “categorical imperative” it takes an imperator! 40[t] — The children of innocence who believe in the “subject” predicate and object, the grammar believers who have not yet heard of our apple of knowledge! 40[12] Teichmüller p. 25° “it is a conclusion when we declare so-called things as being, thus we must therefore know in advance which nature (terminus medius®) the being (terminus major’) possesses, in order to be able to agree with or dispute this concept of things” Against which I say: “think we know in advance.” “Logical laws” in Spir I p. 768 defined as “universal principles of affirmations about objects i.e., an inner necessity to believe something about objects.” My basic ideas: “the absolute” is a regulative fiction that cannot be ascribed any existence, existence does not belong to the necessary qualities of the absolute. Likewise “being,” “substance” [Page 196] 40 AUGUST — SEPTEMBER 1885 189 — all things that should not be drawn from experience, but in fact due to an erroneous interpretation of experience are drawn from it. The previous interpretations all had a certain meaning for life — preserving, making it bearable, or alienating, refining, Concluding J} probably even separating out what is sickly Chapter and bringing it to dying out my new interpretation gives the future philosophers as rulers of the earth the necessary uninhibitedness. 1. Not so much “refuted” as incompatible with what we now chiefly consider “true”

and believe: to this extent the religious and moral interpretation is impossible for us. 40[13]? Logic is bound to the condition: supposing there are identical cases. In fact, so that thinking and inferring can logically take place, this condition must first be feigned as fulfilled. This means: the will to logical truth can only enact itself after a fundamental falsification of all events has been undertaken. From which it follows that here a drive reigns that is capable of both means, first the falsification and then the execution of a single point of view: logic does not stem from the will to truth. 40[14] One could say, the complexity of ways (e.g., of a plant to come to fertilization) would be an argument against intentionality: for here an ingenious spirit would have to be thought, who chooses detours that are too big, clever with respect to the way, stupid regarding precisely the choice of this way — hence a contradictory kind of spirit. But against this interpretation I would point to our human experience: we must exploit this accidental and disrupting element and adopt it into each of our [Page 197] 190 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS drafts, so that everything we execute bears the same character, of a spirit that executes its plan despite many obstacles, therefore with many crooked lines. Let us think of this case translated into tremendous proportions: then the seeming stupidity of the course of the world, the character of wastefulness, of useless sacrifices would perhaps be only an observation from the corner, a perspectival observation for small beings such as we are. In consideration of the fact that we do not know the purposes, it is childish to criticize the means on the basis of their rationality. What is certain is that they are not precisely “humane.” 40[15]!° Judgment, this is the belief: “this and this is so.” Therefore judgment harbors the admission of having encountered an identical case: it presupposes comparison therefore, with the help of memory. The judgment does not succeed in making it appear that an identical case is there. Instead, it believes it perceives such a case; it works under the assumption that identical cases exist generally. Now what do we call that function that is much older, and must be working earlier, that equalizes and assimilates cases that in themselves are dissimilar? What do we call that second one which, based on the first one etc. “What arouses the same sensations is the same”: but what do we call that which makes sensations the same, “takes” them to be the same? —There could be no judgments at all if kind of equalization were not practiced first within the sensations: memory is only possible with a constant underscoring of the already accustomed, experienced — — Before there is judging the process of assimilation must already have been done: therefore here, too, an intellectual activity (is) present, that does not fall under consciousness, as with pain resulting from a wound. Probably there is an inner event corresponding to all organic functions, hence an assimilating, secreting, growing etc. Essential, proceed from the body and use it as a guide. It is the much richer phenomenon that allows for clearer observation. Belief in the body is better established than belief in the

spirit. [Page 198] 40 AUGUST—SEPTEMBER 1885 191 “No matter how strongly a thing may be believed: there is no criterion of truth in it.” But what is truth? Perhaps a kind of belief that has become a condition of life? Then of course strength would be a criterion. E.g., with respect to causality. 40[16]}! What then does all recent philosophy do at bottom? it makes, secretly or openly, an assassination attempt on the old concept of the soul — that is, on the foundation of Christianity, on the “I”: it is antichristian in the most subtle sense. Formerly one believed unconditionally in grammar: one said: “I” is condition, “think” is predicate. One tried with an admirable tenacity to see if one could escape from this net — whether first of all the opposite might not be true: “think” condition — and “T” conditioned, as a synthesis that embarks on thinking. Kant wanted at bottom to prove that the subject could not be proven from the standpoint of the subject, nor the object either. The possibility of an illusory existence of the “subject” is dawning: an idea that has already been on earth once, as in the Vedanta-philosophy. If one wants a new, albeit very provisional expression for it, then read (The Birth of Tragedy) 40[17] Coarsening as a basic means of allowing return, identical cases to appear; thus before anything was “thought” something must have already been made up, the forming sense is more original than the “thinking” one 40[18] On morality. We behave in accordance with the rank order to which we belong: even if we do not know it, even less are able to demonstrate it to others. An imperative “behave according to the rank order to which you belong” is nonsensical: because we would have to know 1) ourselves 2) that order, neither of which is the case — — and 3) because it is superfluous to command something that happens anyway. Rank order: not only in relation to our [Page 199] 192 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS neighbors, rather in certain cases to posterity, likewise to the inhabitants of other planets; for we do not know whether anyone is there who compares us with themselves. — All that is imperatival in morality addresses itself to the multiplicity of masks that we wear in ourselves, and it wants us to display this and not that, hence change our appearance. “Improvement” is: to display something of that which the good humans like — nothing more! 40[19] And as concerns descendants: one has to decide in a clever and timely way — *aut libri aut liberi?* 40[20]!3 Apart from the governesses who even today still believe in grammar as *veritas aeterna!* and consequently as subject predicate and object, no one is so innocent today as to still posit the subject “I” as the condition of “think” in the manner of Descartes; instead, through the skeptical movement of recent philosophy assuming the reverse has become more credible to us, namely thinking as cause and condition of “subject” and “object,” well as of “substance” and of “matter”: which is perhaps only the reverse kind of error.” This much is certain: — we have let go of the “soul” and consequently also the “world soul,” the ‘things in themselves’ as well (as) a world-beginning, a “first cause.” Thinking is not for us

a means of “knowing,” but of describing occurrence, of ordering, of making things handy for our use: this is how we think today about thinking: tomorrow perhaps differently. We do not properly comprehend anymore how “comprehending” is supposed to be necessary, still less how it is supposed to have emerged: and though we (already) constantly get into the plight of having to help ourselves with language and the habits of the popular understanding, still the appearance of constant self-contradiction does not yet testify against the justification of our doubt. Also we are not so easily satisfied anymore with respect to “direct certainty”: we do not even find “reality” and “appearance” to be opposite, rather we would speak of [Page 2] Stanford University Press Stanford, California Translated from Friedrich Nietzsche, *Sämtliche Werke*: Kritische Studienausgabe, ed. Giorgio Colli and Mazzino Montinari, in 15 vols. This book corresponds to Vol. 11, pp. 423-710, and Vol. 12, pp. 9-184. Critical edition of Friedrich Nietzsche’s *Sämtliche Werke* and unpublished writings based on the original manuscripts. © Walter de Gruyter & Co., Berlin and New York, for the German Edition © Adelphi Edizioni, Milan, for the Italian Edition © Editions Gallimard, Paris, for the French Edition © Hakusuisha Publishing Comp., Tokyo, for the Japanese Edition © 2020 by the Board of Trustees of the Leland Stanford Junior University for the English Edition and associated apparatus. All rights reserved. No part of this book may be reproduced or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or mechanical, including photocopying and recording, or in any information storage or retrieval system without the prior written permission of Stanford University Press. Printed in the United States of America on acid-free, archival-quality paper CIP data appears at the end of the book. [Page 20] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 3 regular this may be, we do not comprehend it as necessary. — Yet we can consecutively determine different series of such successions: e.g., in piano playing the succession of struck keys, the succession of struck strings, the succession of sounding notes. 34153] Critique of the instinct of causality. The belief that an action happens on the basis of a motive was instinctively, gradually generalized at the time when everything that happened was imagined in the manner of conscious living beings. “Every occurrence happens on the basis of a motive: the *causa finalis* is the *causa efficiens*” — This belief is erroneous: purpose, motive are means to make the occurrence palpably practicable to us. — The generalization was likewise erroneous and illogical. No purpose. No will. 34154] The inverted order of time. The “external world” acts upon us: the effect is telegraphed to the brain, where it is arranged, shaped and traced back to its cause: then the cause is projected and only now does the fact enter our consciousness. T.e., “the world of appearance” first appears like a cause after “it” has acted and the effect has been processed. Le., we constantly invert the order of what is happening. — Whereas “T” see, it already sees something else. The situation is like that of pain. 34155] The belief

in the senses. Is a fundamental fact of our intellect, which receives from them the raw material that it interprets. This relationship to the raw material offered by the senses is, morally speaking, not accompanied by the intention to truth, but instead purely by a will to overpowering, assimilation, nourishment. Our constant functions are absolutely egoistical, [Page 200] 40 AUGUST — SEPTEMBER 1885 193 degrees of being — and perhaps even more preferably of degrees of appearance — and that “direct certainty” e.g., of the fact that we think and that consequently thinking has reality we would still sour with the doubt of what degree this being has; whether perhaps as “ideas of God” we are indeed real, but fleeting and illusory like rainbows. Supposing that in the nature of things there were something deceptive silly something fraudulent, then the very best will *de omnibus dubitare*® in the manner of Descartes would not guard us from the traps of this nature; and precisely that Cartesian method could be a major trick to thoroughly fool us and take us for fools. Indeed, already insofar as we would actually have reality, in the opinion of Descartes, we as reality would have to share somehow in that fraudulent deceptive ground of things and its grounding-will: — enough, “I do not want to be deceived” could be the method of a deeper more subtle more thorough will, that wanted precisely the reverse: namely to deceive itself. In summa:” it is to be doubted whether “the subject” can prove itself — for this it would simply have to have a firm point outside and that is lacking! 40[21]’8 Point of departure from the body and from physiology: why? — We gain the right idea of the nature of our subject-unity, namely as regents at the head of a community, not as “souls” or “vital forces,” likewise of the dependence of these regents on the ruled and of the conditions of rank order and division of labor as enablement of individuals and the whole simultaneously. Likewise how living unities constantly emerge and die and how eternity is not part of the “subject”; likewise that struggle also expresses itself in obeying and commanding and a fluid determination of power limits is part of life. The certain ignorance in which the regent is kept regarding the individual arrangements and even disturbances of the community belongs to the conditions under which ruling can take place. In brief, we gain an appreciation for not-knowing, too, for seeing on the [Page 201] 194 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS whole and coarsely, for simplifying and falsifying, for the perspectival. But the most important thing is: that we understand the ruler and his subjects as identical in kind, all of them feeling, willing, thinking — and that we also learn to infer a corresponding subjective invisible life wherever we see or detect movement in the body. Movement is a symbolism for the eye; it signifies that something has been felt, willed, thought. — Direct questioning of the subject about the subject, and all self mirroring of the spirit has its dangers in the fact that for its activity it could be useful and important to falsely interpret itself. This is why we ask the body and reject the testimony of the sharpened senses: if you wish, we look into

whether the subordinates themselves are capable of establishing contact with us. 40[22] NB. “Something is thought: consequently there exists something that thinks” — this is what Descartes’s argumentation amounts to — but it is not the reality of a thought that Descartes wanted. He wanted to get beyond “imagination” to a substance that thinks and imagines. 40[23] Let us be more careful than Descartes, who got caught up in the trap of words. Cogito’ is only a word to be sure: but it means something manifold: many a thing is manifold, and we grab at it crudely believing full well that it is one thing. In that famous cogito there is 1) it thinks 2) and I believe that it is I who is thinking here, 3) but even assuming that this second point remains hanging, as a matter of faith, then also that first “it thinks” contains another belief: namely, that “thinking” is an activity for which a subject, at least an “it” must be thought: — and the ergo sum?? means nothing more than this! But this is the belief in grammar, here “things” and their “activities” are already posited, and we are far away from direct”! certainty. Let us therefore leave that problematic “it” out and let [Page 202] 40 AUGUST — SEPTEMBER 1885 195 us say cogitatur as fact without articles of faith mixed in: thus we deceive ourselves again, for the passive form also includes articles of faith and not only “facts”: in summa, precisely the facts of the case cannot be set forth nakedly, “believing” and “presuming” are harbored in the cogito of cogitat? and cogitatur: who will guarantee that with ergo we do not extract something out of this believing and presuming and that what remains: something is believed, therefore something is believed — a false form of deduction! Ultimately one would have to know what “being” is in order to extract a sum from the cogito, one would likewise already have to know; what knowing is: one proceeds from faith in logic — in the ergo above all! — and not only from the setting forth of a fact! — Is “certainty” possible in knowing? is direct certainty not perhaps a contradictio in adjecto? What is knowing in relation to being? But for someone who brings already finished articles of faith to all these questions, the Cartesian cautiousness no longer has any meaning at all: it comes much too late. Before the question of “being” the question of the value of logic would have to be decided. 40[24]” One should not embellish and tidy up the naïveté of D(escartes), as e.g., Spir does. Consciousness is directly certain to itself: the existence of thinking cannot be denied, nor doubted, for this very denial or this doubt are themselves conditions of thinking or of consciousness, their own existence therefore proves what they deny, and consequently they are deprived of any significance.” Spir I, 26. “Something is thought,” therefore something is, namely “thinking.” Was this the meaning of Descartes? Teichmüller p- 5 and 40 there are passages. “Something that is directly certain to itself” is nonsense. Supposing e.g., God thought through us, and our thoughts, insofar as we felt ourselves as cause, were an illusion, then the existence of the thoughts would not be denied or doubted, but certainly the ergo sum. Otherwise he would [Page 203] 196 UNPUBLISHED

FRAGMENTS have to have said: ergo est. — There are no direct certainties: cogito, ergo sum presupposes that one knows what “thinking” is and secondly what “being” is: therefore, if the est (sum) were true, it would be a certainty on the basis of two correct judgments, with the added certainty that one has a right generally to the conclusion, to ergo —therefore in any case no “direct” c(ertainty). Namely: in cogito is harbored not only some kind of event, which is simply acknowledged — this is nonsense! — but a judgment that it is this and that event, and whoever e.g., did not know how to distinguish between thinking feeling and willing could not establish the event at all. And in sum or est is still harbored such a conceptual imprecision that not even fit?° or “it is done” are refuted. “Something is happening there” could be substituted for “there is something there, there exists something, there is something.” 40[25] The belief in the direct certainty of thinking is one more belief, and no certainty! We moderns are all opponents of Descartes and resist his dogmatic carelessness in doubting. “Doubting must be done better than Descartes!” We find the opposite, the countermovement against the absolute authority of the goddess “reason” wherever there are profounder human beings. Fanatical logicians managed to convince us that the world is a deception; and that only in thinking the path to “being,” to the “absolute” is given. By contrast I take pleasure in the world éf it is supposed to be deception; and among more complete h(umans) there has always been ridicule about the common sense of the most sensible. 40[26]7 Apparently contradictory the 2 qualities that distinguish modern Europeans: the individualistic and the demand for equal rights. I finally understand this. Namely the individual is an extremely vulnerable vanity: — the latter demands, with its awareness of how quickly it suffers, that every other is regarded as equal to it, that it is only inter pares.” Therewith a social race is characterized in which in fact the talents and [Page 204] 40 AUGUST —SEPTEMBER 1885 197 strengths do not vary considerably. Pride, which wants solitude and few appreciators, is completely beyond comprehension; the very “great” successes exist only through masses, indeed one scarcely comprehends that a mass-success is really always a small success: because pulchrum est paucorum hominum”? — All the moralities know nothing of the “rank order” of human beings; the law teachers nothing of the community-conscience. The individual-principle rejects the truly great human beings and among those who are roughly equal it demands the most subtle eye and the fastest recognition of a talent; and because everyone has something in the way of talents, in such late and civilized cultures, and accordingly can expect to win back his share of honors, today therefore an emphasizing of the small merits is taking place as never before: — it gives the age a patina of unlimited fairness. Its unfairness consists of a rage without bounds not against the tyrants and demagogues, also in the arts, but against the noe h(umans) who despise the praise of the many. The demand for equal rights

(e.g., to be allowed to sit in judgment over everything and everyone) is anti-aristocratic. Likewise foreign to it is the vanished individual, the submerging into a large type, the will-to-be-a-nonperson: in which the distinction and the ambition of many superior human beings formerly consisted (among them the greatest poets); or “city existence” as in Greece; Jesuitism, Prussian officer corps and bureaucracy; or being a disciple and continuator of great masters: for which unsocial conditions and the lack of petty vanity are necessary 40[27] Just as mathematics and mechanics for long periods were regarded as sciences with absolute validity and only now the suspicion dares to unveil itself that they are nothing more and nothing less than applied logic based on the specific unverifiable assumption that there are “identical cases” —but logic itself a consequential hieroglyphics on the basis of the executed assumption (that there are identical cases) — : so too [Page 205] 198 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS the word formerly qualified as the knowledge of a thing, and even now the grammatical functions are the best-believed things, against which one cannot sufficiently guard oneself. It is possible that the same kind of human being who later thought up Vedanta-philosophies, thousands of years earlier probably thought up a philosophical language on the basis of imper(fect) languages, not, as they believed, as hieroglyphics, but as “knowledge of the world” itself: but whatever “this is” may have been postulated so far, a later and subtler age has discovered again and again that it is nothing more than “this means.” Even today most philos(ophers) do not have even an inkling of the actual critique of concepts or (as I once described it) a real “history of the emergence of thinking.” One should uncover and reevaluate the valuations that lie around logic: e.g., “the certain is of more value than the uncertain” “thinking is our highest function”; likewise the optimism in the logical, the triumphal awareness in every inference, the imperatival in judgment, the innocence in the belief in the comprehensibility of the concept.*? 40[28] There must have been thinking long before there were eyes: “lines and shapes” therefore are not given from the beginning, rather, thinking has occurred for the longest time based on sensations of touch: but this, not supported by the eye, teaches degrees of pressure sensation, not yet shapes. Hence prior to the practice of understanding the world as moved shapes lies the period in which it was “grasped” as changeable and degree-differential pressure sensation. There is no doubt that thinking can occur in images, in sounds: but also in pressure sensations. The comparison with respect to strength and direction and sequence, memory etc. 40[29]?! We must relearn with respect to memory: here lurks the major seduction of assuming a “soul,” which timelessly reproduces, [Page 206] 40 AUGUST —SEPTEMBER 1885 199 recognizes etc. But what is experienced’? continues to live “in » en C ns . . memory’; that it “comes” is beyond my control, for this the will is inactive, as in the coming of any thought. Something happens of which I become aware: now something

similar comes —who calls it? awakens it? 40[30] The great danger inheres in the assumption that there is direct knowing (therefore “knowing” in the strict sense generally!) Teichmüller p. 35.3 40[31] This would have to be something, not subject, not object, not energy, not material, not spirit, not soul: — but someone will tell me that something of this kind would have to look like the spitting image of a hallucination? I believe this myself: and bad if it did not do that! Indeed: it must also look like the spitting image of everything else that there is and that could be, and not only of the hallucination! It must have the great family feature by which everything recognizes itself as related to it — — 40[32] Supposing you were to ask: “Did the tree already look green 50,000 years ago?” then I would answer: “perhaps not yet: perhaps back then there were only the two main contrasts of valeurs, darker and lighter masses: — and gradually colors evolved from them. 40[33] Before logic, which operates everywhere with equations, equating, assimilating must have reigned: and it continues to reign, and logical thinking is itself an ongoing means of assimilation, of wanting-to-see identical cases. 40[34] Our “memory,” whatever it might be, may serve us as a metaphor for describing something important with it: in the [Page 207] 200

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS development of every organic being a prodigy of memory for its overall prehistory reveals itself, to the extent organic beings have a prehistory — and to be sure a reproducing memory that reproduces the earliest and longest-embodied forms sooner than the recently experienced: reaches back in this manner and does not go step by step, as one would have to assume, with a regressus” from the most recent to the most-distantly experienced, rather precisely the opposite way round it leaves aside for the time being everything more recent and freshly imprinted. Here an amazing arbitrariness exists: — Even the “soul,” which is usually called upon to help in all philosophical predicaments, is incapable of helping here: at least not the individualsoul, but a soul-continuum that reigned in the entire process of a certain organic series. Then again: because not everything is reproduced, but only basic forms, then in every memory a subsuming thinking, simplifying, reducing must constantly take place: enough, something analogous to what we describe as “logic” from the standpoint of our consciousness. — And how far might this reproduction go of the previously experienced? Certainly also as far as the reproduction of trains of feeling and thought. But how do (we) regard the “innate ideas” that Locke called into question?*

There is certainly much more true than only this, that ideas are innate, assuming one does not underscore the act of birth in the word “innate.” 40[35] The universal mendacity of human beings about themselves, the moral interpreting of what they do and want, would be despicable if it were not also something very funny: and it really would require spectators — so interesting is the spectacle! Not by the kind of gods Epicurus imagined! But by Homeric gods: as distant and near to humans and

watching them as Galiani perhaps stood in relation to his cats and monkeys: — thus related a bit to humans, but of a higher species! [Page 208] 40 AUGUST — SEPTEMBER 1885 201 40[36] Mathematical physicists cannot use the particle-atom for their science: consequently they construct themselves a forcepoints-world with which one can reckon. Exactly the same, on a crude scale, has been done by humans and all organic creatures: namely they positioned, thought, and fictionalized the world to suit themselves for so long that they were able to use it, until they were able to “reckon” with it. 40[37] Should it not suffice for us to think of “force” as a unity in which willing sensing and thinking are still mixed and undifferentiated? And the organic beings as approaches to separation, so that all the organic functions are still together in that unity, thus self-regulation, assimilation, nourishment, excretion, metabolism? Ultimately nothing is given as “real” except thinking and sensing and drives: is it not permitted to attempt whether this given does not suffice to construct the world? I do not mean as appearance: but precisely as real as our willing feeling thinking are — but as a more primitive form of them. In the end the question is this: whether we acknowledge the will really as effecting? If we do this, then naturally it can only have effect on something that is of its kind: and not on “materials.” Either one must interpret all effect as illusion (for we have formed our idea of cause and effect only according to the model of our will as cause!) and then nothing at all is comprehensible: or one must attempt to think all effects as being of the same kind, like acts of will, hence make the hypothesis as to whether all mechanical events, insofar as there is a force in them, are not simply force of will. — “Mortal souls” with resp. {ect} to the impossibility of transferring the numerical relationship to these things. Against the individual. “Counting” is only a simplification, like all concepts. Namely: wherever something should be thought purely [Page 209] 202 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS arithmetical, quality is calculated away. Likewise in everything logical, where the identity of *caes* is the assumption, therefore the actual spec(ial) character of each event is simply thought away (the new, not to be understood from the conditions of emergence — or r(esp(ectively) included.) 40[38] What it boils down to is properly characterizing the unity in which thinking willing and feeling and all affects are combined: obviously the intellect is only a tool, but in whose hands? Certainly the affects: and these are a multiplicity behind which it is not necessary to posit a unity: it suffices to construe it as a regency. — That the organs have everywhere taken shape, as is shown by morphological development, may also certainly be used as a metaphor for the intellectual: so that something “new” is to be construed always only through the separation of a single force from a synthetic force. Thinking itself is the kind of action that takes apart what is actually One. Everywhere is the appearance that there are countable multiplicities, already in thinking as well. There is nothing “added” in reality, nothing “divided,” a thing

half and half is not equal to the whole. 40[39] Physicists are now of one mind with all metaphysicians that we live in a world of deception: fortunate that one no longer needs to settle up with a God on this issue, about whose “truthfulness” one could come to odd ideas. The perspectival nature of the world goes as deep as our “understanding” of the world reaches today; and I would dare to apply it even where human beings generally should in fairness be allowed to look away from understanding — I mean where metaphysicians (posit) the realm of the seeming certain-to-itself, understandable-to-itself, a(nd) in thinking. That number is a perspectival form, as well as time and space, that we no more harbor “one soul” in a breast than “two souls,”³ that “individuals” like [Page 21] 14 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS Machiavellian, unscrupulous, subtle. Commanding and obeying driven to the highest extreme, and in order that there can be complete “obedience,” the individual organ has much freedom. The error of believing in purposes. Will — a superfluous assumption. The inverted order of time. Critique of the belief in causality. The belief in the senses, as the fundamental fact of our being. The central-force — must not be essentially different from that which it rules. The history of emergence does not explain qualities. The latter must already be known. Historical explanation is reduction to a succession to which we are accustomed: by analogy. 34156] The mechanistic explanation of the world is an ideal: to explain as much as possible with as little as possible, i.e., to put it in formulas. Still needed: the denial of empty space; to think space as defined and limited; just like the world as eternally repeating itself. 34157] How a people’s character, a “people’s soul” emerges provides information about the emergence of the individual soul. First a series of activities is forced upon a people, as conditions of existence, it grows accustomed to them, they become firmer and establish themselves more deeply. Peoples who experience great transformations and end up under new conditions show a new grouping of their strengths: this and that emerges and gets the upper hand because it is now more necessary for existence, e.g., the practical, sober sense of today’s Germans. All character is first role. The “personality” of philosophers — at bottom persona. [Page 210] 40 AUGUST —SEPTEMBER 1885 203 material “atoms” can no longer be maintained, except for the daily-domestic use of thinking, and (have) fled into a nothingness (or into a “formula”), that nothing living and dead can be added together, that both concepts are false, that there are not three faculties of the soul, that “subject” and “object” “activum and passivum” “cause and effect” “means and purpose” are always only perspectival forms, in summa that the soul, substance, number, time, space, ground, purpose —stand and fall together. But supposing now that we are not so foolish as to value truth, in this case the x, higher than appearance, supposing we have resolved to /ive — then we do not want to be dissatisfied with this seemingness of things and only firmly embrace that no one pauses at any kind of ulterior

motives in the representation of this perspectivity: — which in fact has happened so far to nearly all philosophers, for they all had ulterior motives and loved their “truths” — Indeed: here we have to throw open the problem of truthfulness: supposing we live as a result of error, what then can the “will to truth” be? Would it not have to be a “will to death”? — Would the striving of philosophers and scientific people perhaps be a symptom of degenerating dying-out life, a kind of life-weariness of life itself? Quaeritur: and here one could really become contemplative. 40[40] Skepticism Toward the Skeptics. — What happiness a delicate dawn gives to things! How all of life glows with beautiful appearances! So far it was the great falsifications and explanations that raised us up above the happiness of animals — into the human! And conversely: what so far has the creaking of the logical clockwork, the self-reflection of the intellect, the unwinding of the instincts brought with it? Supposing you had reduced everything to formulas and your faith to degrees of probability: because you could not live according to them, what? are you supposed to live with bad conscience? And once human beings perceive their belief in goodness justice and truth in the ground of things as hair-raising falsification: how [Page 211] 204 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS are they themselves supposed to feel, insofar as they (are) indeed part and parcel of this world? As something hair-raising, false: — — — 40/41] There are no direct sensations Spir 2 p. 56.*° no direct pain feelings no direct thoughts If there were a direct knowing, then one could not speak, like J. S. Mill, of the “relativity of knowing.” 40[42]*! The assumption of a single subject is perhaps not necessary; perhaps it is equally permissible to assume a multiplicity of subjects, whose working together and struggle underlie our thinking and generally our consciousness? A kind of aristocracy of “cells” in which ruling resides? Certainly of pares,*? who together are accustomed to ruling and know how to command? My hypotheses: The subject as multiplicity pain as intellectual and dependent on the judgment “harmful”: projected effect always “unconscious”: the inferred and imagined “cause” is projected, follows after time. pleasure as a kind of pain. the single force that exists is of the same kind as the will’s, a commanding of other subjects, who change themselves accordingly. the constant transitoriness and fleetingness of the subject, “mortal soul” number as perspectival form. 40[43]*° Within a herd, every community, therefore inter pares, the overestimation of truthfulness makes good sense. Not to let oneself be deceived — and consequently, as personal morality, not to [Page 212] 40 AUGUST — SEPTEMBER 1885 205 practice deception oneself! A mutual obligation among equals! It is to the outside that danger and caution demand us to be on guard against deception: as a psychological precondition for this also inside. Distrust as the source of truthfulness. 40[44] Supposing the world were false, life were understandable only on the ground of delusion, under the protection of delusion, based on delusion: what then would “live according to

nature” mean? Could the exhortation not be precisely: “be a deceiver”? Indeed, how could one prevent oneself deceiving? We err about ourselves and are incomprehensible to ourselves: how much more are we this for our “neighbors”! But they do not believe themselves to be deceived by us — and it is with that in mind that all dealings with mutual rights and obligations are based. — That deceiving is not part of my intention, admitted! But looked at more closely: I also do nothing to enlighten my neighbors about the fact that they deceive themselves about me. I do not prevent their error, I do not fight it, I let it happen — : in this sense I am indeed the deceiver in the end on purpose. But I also behave exactly the same toward myself: self-knowledge does not belong among the feelings of obligation; even if I seek to know myself, it happens for reasons of utility or a more refined curiosity — but not out of the will to truthfulness. — That the truthful one is more valuable than the liar in the economy of humanity would still have to be proven. The very great and powerful were deceivers so far: their task demanded it of them. Assuming it turned out that living and getting ahead were only possible on the basis of a consistent and lengthy period of being deceived: then the consistent deceivers could achieve highest honors as ones who condition life and promote life. That one harms by not telling the truth is the belief of the naive, a kind of frog-perspective of morality. If life and the value of life rest on well-believed errors, then precisely the truth-teller, the truth-willer could be the harmful one (as the unwinder of illusions). [Page 213] 206 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 40[45]*4 The Philosopher of the Future. Thoughts on Discipline and Cultivation.“ 40[46] NB. Our distant future determination reigns over us, even if we do not yet have an eye open for it; for long periods of time we experience only riddles. Our choice of people and things, our selection of events, the pushing away of what is most pleasant, often of what is most revered — it frightens us, as if here and there chance, a random act were bursting out of us like a volcano: but it is the higher reason of our future task. Seen forwards everything that happens to us might seem like only the unanimity of chance and nonsense: seen backwards I for my part am no longer able to find anything of either of them in my life. 40[47] Descent. What is noble? The emergence of the nobility. The imitating talents as in Voltaire. ‘The great separation. The seven solitudes. The will to power. 40[48]*° On the Order of Rank. Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future. Book One: Cultivation and Discipline. Book Two: The Great Separation. Book Three: The Seven Solitudes. Overcoming Morality. Book Four: The Will to Power. 40[49] Let us be suspicious of all seeming “simultaneity”! Time fragments insert themselves here, which can only be called small [Page 214] 40 AUGUST—SEPTEMBER 1885 207 according to a crude standard, e.g., our human standard of time; but in abnormal circumstances, e.g., as hashish smokers or in a moment of mortal danger, even we humans have a sense of how in one second of our pocket watch a thousand thoughts can be

thought, a thousand experiences experienced. When I open my eyes the visible world stands there, apparently immediately: but in the meantime something tremendous has happened, multifarious things have occurred: — first second third: but here the ph(ysiologists) should speak! 40[50]*” Herewith under the not undangerous title “The Will to Power” a new philosophy or, spoken more clearly, the attempt at a new interpretation of all events, should have its say: as is fair only provisionally and as an attempt, only in preparation and questioningly, only “as prelude” to an earnestness for which initiated and chosen ears are required, as goes without saying, incidentally — or at least should go without saying — for everything that a ph(ilosopher) says publicly. But today, thanks to the superficial and presumptuous spirit of an age that believes in the “equality of all rights,” it has gotten to the point that one absolutely no longer — — — For every philosopher should have the virtues of an educator to the extent that before he undertakes to convince, he must first know how to persuade. Indeed, before proving anything the seducer has to undermine and shock, before any commanding and leading he must first ascertain the extent to which he also knows how to seduce. 40[51] Concepts are something that lives, consequently also something now growing, now receding: many concepts have died a miserable death. As a metaphor they would probably have to be described as cells, with a cell nucleus and a surrounding body that is not firm and — — — [Page 215] 208 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 40[52] There are fateful words that seem to express a knowledge and in truth prevent a knowledge; to them belongs the word “appearances.” Let these propositions I have borrowed from various modern philosophers reveal what chaos these “appearances” can perpetrate. against the word “appearances.” 40[53] NB. Appearance*® as I understand it is the actual and single reality of things — that which first merits all existing predicates and which relatively speaking is best described with all, therefore even the most opposing predicates. But with this word nothing more can be expressed than its inaccessibility for logical procedures and distinctions: therefore “appearance” as opposed to “logical truth” — but which itself is only possible in an imaginary world. Thus I do not posit “appearance” in opposition to “reality” but conversely take appearance as the reality that resists transformation into an imaginary “truthworld.” A specific name for this reality would be “the will to power,” namely described from the inside and not from the standpoint of its incomprehensible fluid protean nature. 40[54] The deliberateness of actions is nothing decisive in morality (belongs to the myopic individualistic tendency). “End” and “means” in relation to the entire species from which they grow are only symptomatic, ambiguous in themselves and nearly incomprehensible. Animals and plants show their moral character according to the life conditions in which they are placed. What is decisive lies only behind “deliberateness.” One will never be allowed to isolate the individual: “Here, one must say, is a growth

with such a prehistory.” 40155] Nature’s conformance to law is a false humanitarian interpretation. What is at stake is an absolute determination of power [Page 216] 40 AUGUST —SEPTEMBER 1885 209 relationships, the whole brutality, without the alleviation brought along by the anticipation of the future, caution and cunning and prudence, in brief by the intellect in organic life. The absolute momentariness of the will to power reigns; in the human being (and already in the cell) this determination is a process that continually displaces itself in the growth of all participants — a struggle, assuming that one understands this word broadly and deeply enough still to understand the relationship of the ruler to the ruled as one of wrestling, and the relationship of the obeyer to the ruler as one of resisting. 40[56] 1. On Noble and Common Morality. “The ethical”: a type of human being is supposed to be preserved. Noble morality. What is human is supposed to be preserved to some kind of degree: common morality. 2. The intentionality of actions. 3. Evil in the virtues. 4. The bad drives and their utility. 40[57] NB! But is something at rest really happier than everything in motion? Is the immutable really and necessarily more valuable than a thing that changes? And if someone contradicts himself thousands of times and walks many paths and wears many masks and finds in himself no end and (no) final line on the horizon: is it more probable that such a man experiences less of the “truth” than a virtuous stoic who has placed himself on his spot once and for all, like a pillar and with the hard hide of a pillar? But these kinds of prejudices have sat at the threshold to all philosophy so far: and especially the one that certainty is better than uncertainty and open seas, and that appearance is what a philosopher has to fight as his actual enemy. [Page 217] 210 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 40[58] There is little importance now in people knowing what I really wanted back then from Richard Wagner (although the reader of my *Birth of Tragedy* will not be in the dark about that), indeed, that I, through a longing of this kind, definitely proved in the most thorough manner how seriously I erred about him and his talent. Enough, that my error — including my belief in a shared and compatible destiny — does dishonor neither to him nor me and, in any case, was no small refreshment and boon to us both at the time, as two men isolated in very different ways. The moment came when I sensed to what extent I had wanted much too much with respect to Richard Wagner: and, somewhat later, the even worse moment when he my — — — 40[s]” Conclusion of “In Relations with Others” Preface and Prequestion: “what are free spirits?” (1) “Through its health, a soul in which dwells the wisdom of the world must make even the body healthy”: thus says Montaigne,”? and today I gladly say my Yes to that, as someone who has experience in this sphere. “There can be nothing more cheerful, more alert, I would almost have said more fun than the world and its wisdom”: thus likewise I speak with Montaigne — but under what pale and horrific masks did wisdom pass me by at that time! Enough, I was afraid of it

often enough and did not like being alone with it like that — — — and embarked, alone and in silence, but with a tenacious “will to wisdom” and to the south — on wandering. Back then I privately called myself a “free spirit,” or “Prince Vogelfrei”™! and if anyone had asked me: where is your home anyway, I would have answered him “maybe beyond good and evil, otherwise nowhere.” But I insisted firmly that I had no wandering comrades: then one day I cast my fishing line in search of other [Page 218] 40 AUGUST — SEPTEMBER 1885 211 “free spirits” — with precisely this book, to which I have already given the title “A Book for Free Spirits.” Today of course — what does one not learn after all in ten years! — I scarcely know any more whether I am seeking companions and “wandering comrades.” For in the meantime I learned what few now understand, to bear solitude, “understand” — solitude, and today I would place it right there among the essential characteristics of a “free spirit” that he would rather walk alone, rather fly alone, indeed, if he happened to have sick legs, rather crawl alone. Solitude kills if it does not heal: this is true; solitude is part of a wicked and dangerous art of healing. But it is certain that when it heals it also sets up a human being in a healthier and more self-affirming way than a human being could ever stand in society, or a tree in its woods: solitude tests most thoroughly, more than any illness itself, whether someone is born and destined for fe — or for death, like most people. Enough, I first learned from solitude how to think to the end the complementary concepts “free spirit” and “health.” 2. We “free spirits” live apart and here and there on earth — this cannot be changed; we are few — and this is fair. It belongs to our pride to think that our kind is a rare and unusual kind; and we do not crowd together, we probably do not even “long” for each other. To be sure: if we happen to meet once, like today, then there is a celebration! When we use the word “happiness” in the sense of our philosophy, then we are not thinking above all like the weary, fearful and suffering among the philosophers of external peace, of painlessness, immobility, undisturbedness, of a “Sabbath of Sabbaths,” of something that might resemble deep sleep in value. On the contrary, our world is the uncertain, the changing, capable of transforming, ambiguous, a dangerous world! certainly more than the simple world that always stays the same, predictable, fixed, to which philosophers so far have given highest honors, as heirs of the herd instinct and herd valuations. Known in many lands of the spirit and driven about etc. [Page 219] 212 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 3. Have these words described you? Or have they only concealed you in a new way? I do not know: but you tell me in any case that you think I have erred in using this name? That the name “free spirit” has been anticipated? That it misleads? That people will mistake us on the basis of this name? — But why, among us, my friends, why indeed should we not mislead? What does it matter that people mistake us? Will we therefore mistake ourselves? And in the end: would it perhaps not be worse if — —? Well then, I understand you: you

absolutely want another, a new name! “Out of pride” you tell me: the best argument on which to base any stupidity. Thus I will start over again: now open your ears to my novelties! — But here you interrupt me, you free spirits. “Enough, Enough! I hear you shouting and laughing — we cannot take it any more! Oh you horrific fool! You virtuous traitor and slanderer! Do you want to ruin our reputation throughout the world? Blacken our good name? Saddle us with nicknames that eat their way into not only our skin? Be quiet, you disturber of the conscience’s peace! And why, on a bright sunny day, these gloomy grimaces, these gurgling noises, this whole raven-black music? If you speak truths: there are no feet that could dance to these truths, therefore they are no truths for us. Ecce nostrum veritatis sigillum? And here is lawn and soft ground: what would be better than to swiftly chase away your mopey thoughts and make ourselves a good day after your ‘night’? But someone has to strike up the tune for us! And first let’s get rid of all these storm clouds! It is high time that a rainbow stretched itself again over the land, some colorful beautiful bridge of lies upon which only spirits, very free, very airy merry spirits can walk! And lastly and firstly: have you no milk to drink? You yourself have made us thirsty for your milk!” — “As much as you want, my friends. There you see my herd leaping, all my tender sunny sheltered lambs and rams: [Page 22] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 15 34158] Numbers are our major means for making the world manageable. We comprehend as far as we can count, i.e., as far as a constancy can be perceived. 34[59]” The course of philos(ophy) has so far been impeded most by moral ulterior motives. 34[60] Even within our world of the senses, if only we sharpen or think of it sharpened, a world arises that has a quite different effect on our feeling 34[61] The prejudice of causality the prejudice of will the prejudice of purpose the prejudice of personality Knowledge: a false concept i.e., a concept we have no right to propose. Abolition 1) of will 2) of purposes as “why” and “by what means” 3) consequently also of causality (which derives from both) 34[62]° “How are synthetic judgments a priori possible?” — “dy means of a faculty for them” was the famous Kantian answer, which gave such satisfaction to many. 34163] The most useful concepts have survived: however falsely they may have originated. [Page 220] 40 AUGUST -SEPTEMBER 1885 213 and here standing waiting for you already is a whole pail full of milk, a pail full of freshly milked truths, still warm enough to make you warm again. Incipit: °? ‘Human All Too Human: Good Milk for Free Spirits.’ Do you want to drink some? It is lovely to be silent together — — —* 40[60] Artist-pessimism. — There are very different kinds of artists. If Richard Wagner must be a pessimist, then he is forced into it by his aversion to himself, the worm of manifold self-contempt, the necessity of intoxicants, including his art, in order to tolerate life at all, and again disgust behind the intoxication, added to all this the consciousness of thespianism, the pressure of unfreedom from which everyone suffers who

must disguise himself because he cannot tolerate himself naked — on the other hand his insatiable hunger for praise and noise, because such comedians must always have their belief in themselves bestowed first from the outside and only for moments at a time: — they are not in the least free to renounce praise and noise! But what help are even the most blissful moments of *vanitatum vanitas*, what help is all incense, all self-deification! Immediately afterwards the old grief stirs anew! and above all the storms of passion, or the intemperance masked as passion, in the end an inner weak hesitating voice will always sound forth once more, a sentencing voice: — Such artists involuntarily and unavoidably glorify their “non-ego” in their art, and everything that constitutes the extreme opposite of themselves: those therefore, in the case of Wagner, all extravagant virtues, e.g., absolute loyalty or absolute chastity or the simplicity of a child or ascetic self-sacrifices: so that up to a certain point one would have a right to be suspicious of the character of every artist who always glorifies precisely only extravagant virtues: for that way he wants to get free of himself and he denies himself! But let us be satisfied with this even so! In the end such an artist for all his will to world denial [Page 221] 214 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS actually praises and extols something that is possible in this world: art can be nothing other than world-affirmation! — And my objection, my friends, was no objection. Therefore my friend: one will have noticed from his judgment, even if one does not agree with it, that he loved Wagner very much: for an opponent never takes his subject so profoundly as he does. There is no doubt that insofar as he suffers from Wagner, he also suffers with Wagner. 40[61]*° For the Plan. Our intellect, our will, likewise our sensations are dependent on our valuations: these correspond to our drives and their conditions of existence. Our drives are reducible to the will to power. The will to power is the last factum to which we are able to get down. Our intellect a tool Our will Our feelings of malaise > { already dependent on valuations Our sensations 40[62] The embellishing style of historiography of Ranke, his pussy-footing, in all those passages where what is needed is to record a terrible nonsense of chance as such; his belief in an immanent finger of God as it were, that occasionally pushes and shifts something in the clockwork: for he no longer dares, the super-anxious one, to regard him either as clockwork or as the cause of the clockwork 40[63]” Preface to “Mixed Opinions and Maxims” What kind of human might that be who takes joy in such notations? — Allow me to quickly paint my picture of this kind [Page 222] 40 AUGUST — SEPTEMBER 1885 215 on the nearest best wall: here, on the pages of my “preface.” The last thing I want to do is lay claim to a characterization, a single word for it, even though there might be such a thing: — perhaps someone who sees my picture will find the word himself — the “right word”! This kind of human protects the artist and philosopher but does not mistake himself for them. They are idle, they have the reasonableness for *otium**® 40164]? For a long time

I tried as hard as I could to see a kind of Cagl(iostro) in R. W(agner): one must forgive me this far from innocuous idea, which at least was not inspired by hatred or by revulsion, but by the charm that this incomparable human being exerted on me: add to this that according to my observations the real “geniuses,” the genuine ones of the highest order, all do not “charm” in this manner, so that “genius” alone did not seem to me to suffice as an explanation for that mysterious influence. 40[65]° Preface Whoever has the desires of a high and selective soul will at all times be in great danger: but today it is extraordinary. Thrown into a noisy, rabble-like age with which he does not want to eat from the same bowl, he could easily perish of hunger and thirst, or, in the event he finally “digs in” after all, of disgust. Such a human being must be helped at the right time by a pair of strokes of fortune that somehow manage to balance out whatever harm may have befallen him through an unsatisfied, yearning and isolated youth: for instance that a rigorous occupation is found for him, in whose service he temporarily becomes estranged from himself and his illness, and has to live totally and completely according only to the demands of a brave spirituality. Or that he opens his ears to a ph(ilosopher) who leads him away from everything timely and time-flattering back to [Page 223] 216 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS “more enduring” goals than the present, yet without damaging his pupil’s sense of respect through an excess of denial: that he becomes a friend of good music and even better of good musicians themselves — a great solace (for the good musicians are all hermits and “outside of time”) and a good antidote against an all-too-martial a(nd) wrathful inclination that likes to pounce on the human beings and things of today. It happened late — I was already beyond my twenties in years — when I realized what I was still entirely lacking: namely justice. “What is justice? And is it possible? And should it not be possible, how then would life be bearable?” — this is what I asked myself relentlessly. Wherever I dug in myself, it alarmed me deeply to find only passions, only corner-perspectives, only the unscrupulousness of those who were already lacking the preconditions for justice: but where was the presence of mind? — namely presence of mind from comprehensive insight. The only things I admitted to myself were courage and a certain hardness, which are the fruits of a long self-mastery. In fact it already took courage and hardness to admit so much to myself and moreover so late. Enough, I found reasons and ever better reasons to distrust my praise as well as my blame and to laugh about the judicial dignity that I had presumed for. myself: indeed I finally forbade myself, with shame, any right to Yes and No; at the same time a sudden and intense curiosity awakened for the unknown world in me — in brief, I resolved to go into a hard and long new school and as far as possible away from my corner. Perhaps justice itself would meet up with me for once along the way! Thus began for me a period of wandering. What was really happening to me back then? I did not understand

myself, but the stimulus was like a command. It seems that our distant future determination disposes over us; for a long time we experience only riddles. Our selection of events, what we seize and suddenly crave, the pushing away of what is most pleasant, often of what is most revered: it frightens us as if here and there chance, a random, mad act were [Page 224] 40 AUGUST —SEPTEMBER 1885 217 bursting out of us like a volcano. But it is only the higher reason and caution of our future task. The long sentence of my life wants perhaps — thus I asked myself restlessly — to be read backwards? Forwards, there is no doubt of this, at that time I read only “words without meaning.” A great, ever greater separation, a voluntary going-abroad, an “alienation,” cooling off, sobering up — this alone, nothing more was my desire in those years. I tested everything to which my heart had generally attached itself up to that point, I turned around the best and most beloved things and looked at their other sides, I did the opposite with everything on which the human art of slander and defamation had so far been practiced most subtly. Back then I walked around many things that had so far remained foreign to me with a sparing, even loving curiosity, I learned to perceive our time and everything “modern” — more fairly. On the whole it might have been an uncanny and wicked game; — I was often ill because of it. That separation comes suddenly like an earthquake: the young soul has to see what is happening to it. At the same time it is an illness that can destroy human beings: this first outbreak of strength and will to self-determination; and much more pathological are the first peculiar and wild experiments of the spirit to henceforth shift the world into place on one’s own. But my decision remained standing; and, even ill, I put the best face on my “games” and maliciously defended myself against every conclusion in which illness or loneliness or the exhaustion of wandering could have played a part. “Forward,” I said to myself, “tomorrow you will be healthy, today it suffices for you to feign health.” Back then I gained mastery over everything “pessimistic” in me; the will to health itself, the play-acting of health was my cure. What I perceived and wanted as “health” at the time is expressed comprehensibly and treacherously enough in these sentences (p. 37 of the first edition“): “a stable, mild, and basically cheerful soul, a mood that does not need to be on guard against pranks and sudden outbursts and whose expressions have no grumbling in their [Page 225] 218 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS tone, nor any sullenness — those familiar, burdensome traits of old dogs and people who have been on a chain for a long time” — and “as the most desirable condition that free, fearless hovering above people, customs, laws, and traditional appraisals of things.” — Indeed a kind of bird freedom and bird panorama, something of curiosity and contempt at the same time, whose like is familiar to anyone who surveys a tremendous multifariousness without being involved. — “A free spirit” — (this) cool word does a person good in any condition, it nearly warms; a human being has become the opposite of those who worry about things

that do not concern them; the free spirit — was concerned purely about things that no longer “worry” him. It is of no use that it immediately becomes a hard nut that must be cracked here: — the superior human being, the exceptional human being must, unless he — — — Back then the personal result of all that was (Human, All Too Human, p. 31) as I described it, logical world-denial: namely the judgment that the world that concerns us at all is false. “It is not the world as thing in itself” — this is void, void of meaning and worthy of Homeric laughter! — “but the world as error that is so rich in meaning, deep, and wonderful, bearing happiness and unhappiness in its lap”:^{o*} thus I decreed at the time — . The “overcoming of metaphysics,” “which requires the greatest possible exertion of human presence of mind” (p. 23)[%] I regarded as achieved: and at the same time I posed myself the challenge of maintaining a great grateful meaning for these overcome metaphysics, insofar as “the greatest advancement of humanity” derived from them. But in the background stood the will to a much broader curiosity, indeed to a tremendous experiment: the thought dawned in me as to whether all values did not permit themselves to be reversed, and the question always came back: “what do all human valuations mean anyway? What do they reveal about the conditions of life — your life, and furthermore of human life, ultimately of all life generally? — [Page 226] 40 AUGUST —SEPTEMBER 1885 219 40[66]4 Draft for 2) of the preface: whoever has not experienced similar things does not belong here. A book of preparation. One must write a preface not only to invite, but to scare away. “Our highest insights must and should etc. To avoid being mistaken,[@] I added many things in order to enhance the state to which back then I : it is a necessary transition-state for a few human beings. — Now I could say some things more comprehensibly. Rejection of “freethinkers.” Against the scabies anarchistica.[@] It is a book through which natures that are destined to rule a(nd) lead the way under certain circumstances should be brought to terrible conclusions, to reflection regarding the discipline toward themselves, the kind of superiority and accessibility to many ways of thinking (flexibility) and that tremendous health that even does not want to do without illness for a higher purpose. That discipline and self-mastery of the spirit that is just as much a flexibility of the heart as an art of the mask: that inner comprehensiveness and pampering that permits the walking of paths to many and opposing ways of thinking, without our running the danger of getting lost in or falling in love with them; that tremendous health that even does not want to do without illness, that excess of plastic healing imitating restoring powers 6 40[67]^o” It was at that time that I first developed an eye for history: Ranke. Ignorance in the natural sciences and medicine makes our historians into modest advocates of facta:^{@*} as if for us . c . D» . (9 something good “came of it” after all, some little “finger of God” at least. 40[68]” No. 1 of H. All Too H: The Sphinx. — Conclusion of section I: the new Oedipus. [Page 227] 220

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 40[69] Our “spirit” including feelings and sensations is a tool that is at the service of a many-headed and multifaceted master: this master is our valuations. But our valuations reveal something of what our /ife-conditions are (for the least part the conditions of the person, to a greater extent those of the species “human being,” and to the greatest and widest extent the conditions under which /ife generally is possible). 40[70]”o “German.” Questions and Dashes.”! German Pessimism German Romanticism. The Rediscoverers of the Greeks. German Anarchism. The Dangers of the Jewish Soul. The Literati. Women. Hermits. The Demagogues in Art. German Style. German Music. The South The East (two souths: Venice and Provence) The “Enlightenment” and Modern Ideas. The School Master Culture. Wagnerianism. The Europeans. The German Spirit. The Jews Voila un homme. “Profundity.” The Christian European. 72 [Page 228] [41 = W I 5. August-September 1885] 4i] Sils-Maria end of August 1885 Friedrich Nietzsche, Collected Writings. Early Works. The Birth of Tragedy. Unfashionable Observations. Address on Homer. Human, All Too Human: A Book for Free Spirits. “Between Ourselves”: Mixed Opinions and Maxims. Dawn: Thoughts on the Presumptions of Morality Gai Saber: Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future. Thus Spoke Zarathustra: A Book for All and None. Noon and Eternity: Bequest of a Soothsayer. “Exultabit Solitudo et florebit quasi lilium.” Isaiah. iz}? New Unfashionable Observation. — 1. In our youth we admire and despise like a fool and probably bring forth our tenderest and highest feelings for the interpretation of people and things that do not belong to us, as little as we belong to them. Youth itself is something falsifying and deceiving. It seems that the reverence and the anger suited to youth are unwilling to rest at all until they have “falsified” people and [Page 229] 222 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS things in such a way that it can unleash its emotions on them. Later on, when we have become stronger, deeper, also more truthful, we are startled to discover how little we had our eyes open at the time, when we sacrificed at these altars. We are angered at not having seen all that is vain, exaggerated, fake, varnished, thespian in our beloved idols — we are angered on account of this self-blinding, as if it had been a dishonest blindness. In this transition we take vengeance on ourselves through distrust; we are on guard against our enthusiastic feelings — indeed we feel even “a good conscience” to be a danger, like a self-veiling and weariness of one’s own honesty. One decade later again: and we understand that all this too still — was youth, — 2. — Wha I myself once, in my “young years,” wrote about Schopenhauer and Richard Wagner, and not so much wrote as painted — perhaps in an all too daring super-exuberant and super-youthful æl fresco? — that is what I want least to scrutinize today with an eye toward “true” and “false.” But supposing I had erred back then: my error at least accrues to the dishonor neither of those mentioned, nor of myself! It çs something to err thus; it is also

something to seduce precisely me to error in this manner. In any case it was also an invaluable boon to me, back then when I decided to paint “the philosopher” and “the artist” and my own “categorical imperative” so to speak — to be able to paint my new colors not entirely onto the unreal but as it were on sketched-out figures. Without my knowing it, I spoke only for myself, indeed at bottom only about myself. Meanwhile: Everything that I experienced at the time, those are typical experiences for a certain kind of human being, which in order to be expressed — — — And whoever reads those writings with a young and fiery soul will perhaps guess the solemn oaths with which I bound myself for my life at the time — with which I resolved myself to my life: may he be one of those few who is allowed to resolve himself to a similar life and to similar oaths! [Page 23] 16 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 34164] In the first book shatter the belief in the truth: truthfulness is useful, but only in a small quantity, above all for those who do not have to answer for anything. Likewise respect for philosophers. 34[65] The general coarsening of the European spirit, a certain clumsy straight-forwardness that likes to hear itself praised as straightness, honesty or good science:?” this belongs to the dominance of thinking of the democratic zeitgeist and its humid air: more specifically — it is the effect of reading newspapers. People want convenience or intoxication when they read: by far the majority of what is read is newspaper or newspaper-like. Just look at our revues, our scholarly journals: everyone who writes there speaks as if before “informal company” and lets himself go, or rather sit, in his armchair. — Someone has it rough there if he places the most value on ulterior motives and loves the dashes in his books more than everything that is articulated. — Freedom of the press will drive style to ruin and ultimately the spirit too: Galiani knew this already a hundred years ago. — “Freedom of thought” drives thinkers to ruin.’ — Between hell and heaven, and in the danger of persecution, exile, eternal damnation and the disapproving glances of kings and ladies the spirit had grown supple and daring: alas, what is the “spirit” becoming these days! 34[66] Always ironice:*° it is a precious sensation to watch such a truthful thinker. But it is even more pleasant to discover that this is all foreground, and that at bottom he wants something else and wants it in a very daring manner. I believe this was the magic of Socrates: he had a soul and behind it another and behind it another. In the first Xenophon slumbered, in the second Plato and in the third Plato once more, but Plato with [Page 230] 41 AUGUST —SEPTEMBER 1885 223 3. There came a point in time when I secretly began to laugh about Richard Wagner, back then when he embarked on his last role and appeared before his beloved Germans with the gestures of a miracle man, salvation preacher, prophet, indeed even philosopher. And because I had not yet stopped loving him, my own laughter bit into my heart: as belongs to the story of anyone who becomes independent of his teacher and finally finds his own way. In this period arose the

lively essay that follows below, from which, it seems to me, even today many a young German can profit: — I myself, in my current frame of mind, would wish to have said everything more patiently, also more cordially and considerately. In the meantime I guessed all too much about the painful and horrific tragedy that lies hidden behind the life of such a human being as was Richard Wagner. 4. Richard Wagner has without any doubt Germans etc. 5. But the musician Richard Wagner? — “Richard Wagner and No End”: this is the watchword today. But with that we friends of music are at the end of our patience. For so long we have had to grin and bear the Wagnermania, and with the help of all virtues and kinds of aesthetic we have encouraged and exhorted ourselves throughout a very long rainy day: “how beautiful is even this nasty weather! How many charms lie concealed in the wrinkles of the thunderstorm! How subtly the rain plays the ‘endless melody’! How incomparably the lightning flashes in the midst of long gray gloom! And especially the thunder: how beautiful is the chromatics of the thunder!” But finally, finally we also want to see the clear sky again and at least have the beautiful evening that we deserve after such a virtuous, but so wicked day! — Really? The evening? Is it really “becoming night” already? Is even our best art, music, beginning to nod now? My friends, here is someone who no longer believes in it! It is by no means time for the evening! And Wagner signified neither [Page 231] 224 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS the day nor the night of our art — but only a dangerous interval, an exception and a question mark that put our conscience to the test! We still learned to say No! at the right time: any righteous and profound musician says No to Wagner today and to himself insofar as he still “wagnerizes” — and to be sure the more thoroughly if precisely he was schooled by Wagner, learned from him. 6. Of course it may be all the worse for the musicians who are less skilled, also for those who crave money and honor: precisely for them there are exquisite seductions in Wagner’s manner of making music. For it is easy to compose with Wagnerian methods and tricks, it may also be, given the demagogic craving of today’s artists for excitement of the “masses,” more lucrative, namely “more full of effects,” “more overpowering,” “more striking,” “more gripping” and however else the treacherous favorite words of the theater rabble and the dilettantish fanatics put it. But ultimately, what do noise and the enthusiasm of the “masses” mean in matters of art! Good music never has a “public”: — it is and can never be “public,” it belongs to the most exquisite, it should always and only — speaking in metaphors — exist for the “chamber!” “Masses” can sense the one who knows best how to flatter them, in their way they are grateful for all demagogic talents and return it in kind to the best of their abilities. (How “masses” are able to thank, with what “spirit” and “taste,” for this the death of Victor Hugo provided edifying testimony: in all the centuries of France together, has there been so much France-demeaning nonsense printed and spoken as on this occasion? But

also at the burial of Richard Wagner the flatteries of gratitude spiraled as high as this “pious” wish: “Redemption to the Redeemer!”® —) NB. There is no doubt that W(agnerian) art today has an effect on the masses: that it can do that — should this not constitute a testimonial about this very art? For three good things in art “masses” have never had a sense, for nobility, for logic and for beauty — *pulchrum est paucorum hominum*’ — : not to speak of an even better thing, of grand style, to which so far even the [Page 232] 41 AUGUST—SEPTEMBER 1885 225 most highly evolved artists of modern times were allowed to say neither Yes nor No: — they have not had a right to it yet, they felt distant and ashamed before it, and this shame was in fact precisely their highest height! Wagner stands farthest from grand style: the excessive and heroically ostentatious aspects of his artistic methods stand in direct contrast to grand style; and likewise the tenderly seductive, the manifoldly charming, the restless, uncertain, suspenseful, momentary, mysteriously effusive, the whole “supersensual” masquerade of sick senses, and whatever else might be called “Wagnerian” in the typical sense. And nonetheless, despite his most thorough inability for it: Wagner leers at the grand style, he who is incapable of even ordinary, proper, genuine /ogic! He knows this well enough, he recognized it early on: but immediately he set about, with the ruthless actoradroitness that constitutes his mastery, interpreting his deficiency as an advantage. In the illogical, semi-logical there is much that is seductive: — this is what Wagner thoroughly divined — : namely for Germans with whom obscurity is perceived as “profundity.” He was denied the manliness and rigor of a logical development: but he found “something more full of effect”! “Music,” he taught, “is only ever a means, the end is drama.” Drama? No, the gesture!? — thus at least Wagner personally understood it. Above all and first the gripping gesture! Something that knocks you down and makes you shudder! Who cares about “sufficient reason”! A kind of ambiguity even in the rhythmic phrasing likewise belongs among his favorite artistic methods, a kind of drunkenness and sleepwalking that no longer knows how to “infer” and unleashes a dangerous will to blind following and giving in. Just look at our women when they are “wagnetized”:!° what “unfreedom of the will”! What fatalism in their extinguishing gaze! What letting-go, what submission! Perhaps they even intuit that in this condition of the “unhinged” will they possess one more charm for some kind of men?: what more reason for their worship of their Cagliostro and miracle man! With the actual “maenads” of Wagner-worship one can even confidently 8 [Page 233] 226 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS diagnose hysteria and illness; something or another is not in order with their sexuality; or children are lacking, or in the most bearable case, men. 7. As concerns the youths who pay homage to Wagner, generally speaking they are musically bad. (One of the best even once said to me ingenuously “I understand nothing at all about music, but Wagner unites

everything good that exists today — he is an anti-Semite, vegetarian and abhors vivisection”) Wagnerian youths, in many respects a very refreshing and noble kind of youth — revere in Wagner roughly the same thing that the passionate disciples of Victor Hugo around 1828 revered in their idol: above all the master of big words and gestures, the advocate of all swelling emotions, all sublime instincts, then the daring innovator and shackle-breaker in battle with and in opposition to older stricter, perhaps more restrictive artistic schooling, the opener of new portals, new vistas, new distances, new depths and heights, finally, and not least: these German youths revere in Wagner his commanding nature, the ability to noisily command, to stand on himself alone, to answer to himself alone, to obstinately say Yes to himself, and always in the name of the “chosen people,” the Germans! — in brief, they revere what is tribunal and demagogic in Wagner. Such enthusiastic youths of course still see nothing of the bad, indeed abominable taste of this whole “selfstaging” of Wagner’s: youth simply Aas the right to bad taste — it is their right. But if one wants to learn where the innocence and the unhesitating readiness of youths can be led and seduced by an old drifting pied piper, then just cast a glance at that literary swamp from which ultimately the now aged master loves to sing with his “boys” (is “sing” the right word?) I mean the infamous Bayreuther Blatter.” That is really a swamp: Presumption, Teutonification and conceptual chaos all mixed in the gloomiest way, poured over with an intolerable sugar of “sweetest” compassion, and in between that already mentioned inclination for green vegetables and that purposeful [Page 234] 41 AUGUST —SEPTEMBER 1885 227 anointing and sentimentality for the sake of animals, close beside the unvarnished genuine and thorough hatred for science and generally the scorn and defiling of everything that stands or stood in Wagner’s way — how the nobler nature of Mendelsohn, the purer nature of Schumann stood in the way of his influence! — along with a prudent squinting for new reinforcements, an “accommodation” in the direction of powerful parties, for instance the completely impure playing and ogling with Christian symbols — Wagner, the old atheist, antinomian and immoralist, even at one point unctuously invokes the “blood of the Redeemer”! — on the whole the impudence of an old high priest enveloped by thick smoke, who discloses his obscure emotions like revelations about every conceivable realm of thought that is inaccessible and forbidden precisely to him; and all this in a German, a real swamp-German of obscurity and exaggeration such as perhaps not even the most “German”-hostile disciples of Hegel had achieved! 8. Perhaps only now can it be made clear where Wagner belongs: namely zot in the great series of the authentic and the genuine of the highest order, not at this Olympic “court of courts.” Rather, Wagner is due an entirely different rank and an entirely different honor — and in fact, not a small and mean one: Wagner is one of those three actor-geniuses of art from whom the mob in this century — and it is after all the

“century of the mob!” — practically learned its concept of “artist” in the first place: I mean those three odd and dangerous human beings, Paganini, Liszt, Wagner, dubiously positioned in the middle between “God” and “ape,” who were predestined just as much for “imitation” as for invention, for creating in the art of imitation itself, and whose instincts divined everything that can be discovered and amplified for the purpose of performance, expression, effect, sorcery, seduction. As demonic mediators and art-interpreters they became — and are today the masters of all artists of interpretation generally: everyone in these circles learned [Page 235] 228 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS from them; — this is why the seat and likewise the origin of the actual “Wagner-cult” must be sought among actors and practicing itinerant musicians of all kinds. But apart from these circles, to whom we must concede every right to their belief and superstition,!* and with respect to the total appearance of those three actor-geniuses and their most secret and universal meaning I personally cannot get beyond raising the same question again and again: what is it in those three that seemingly expresses itself as new, is it perhaps only the old and eternal “Cagliostro” after all, only newly costumed, newly staged, “set to music,” set to religion — as it might best correspond with the taste of the new century — the century of the mob, as mentioned? Therefore no longer like the last Cagliostro as the seducer of a noble and exhausted culture, but instead —as demagogical Cagliostro? — And our music, with whose help people are being “bewitched” here: — what, I beg and ask you, does our German) m(us)ic mean! 9. — This date Wagner, at bottom a broken and conquered human being, but one who could not abandon his great playacting, this Wagner who in the end even spoke of the “thrills” that he knew how to extract from the Protestant holy communion while at the same time he stretched out his hands to everything Roman with his Parsifal music: this flatterer of all German vanities, obscurities and presumptions who offered himself everywhere — this late Wagner is supposed to be the ultimate and highest pinnacle of our music and the expression of the finally achieved synthesis of the “German soul,” the German himself? — It was in summer 1876 that I recanted this faith; and therewith began that movement of the German conscience of which today ever more serious, ever more distinct signs are becoming visible — and the decline of Wagnermania! 4il]? There is only nobility of birth, nobility of blood. (I am not speaking here of the little word “von” and the Gothaische Kalender: [Page 236] 41 AUGUST —SEPTEMBER 1885 229 interpolation for asses.) Where people speak of “aristocrats of the spirit,” usually grounds are not lacking for hiding something; it is a well-known favorite term among ambitious Jews. For spirit alone does not ennoble; on the contrary something is first required that ennobles the spirit. — What then is required for this? The blood. aila” German philosophy as a whole — Leibniz, Kant, Hegel, Schopenhauer, to name the great ones — is the most thorough kind of

Romanticism and homesickness that has ever existed: the longing for the best there ever was. One is no longer at home anywhere, ultimately one longs to return to where one can somehow be at home, because only there does one wish to be at home: and that is the Greek world! But precisely to that place all bridges are broken — except the rainbows of concepts! And they lead everywhere, to all homelands and “fatherlands” there have been for Greek-souls! Indeed: One must be very subtle, very light, very thin to step across these bridges! But what happiness lies already in this will to spirituality, almost to ghostliness! How distant one is here from “pressure and thrust,” from the mechanistic silliness of the natural sciences, from the fairground din of “modern ideas”! People want to return to the Greeks through the church fathers, from the north to the south, from the formulas to the forms; they still enjoy the outcome of antiquity, Christianity, as an entrance to antiquity, as a good piece of the old world itself, as a gleaming mosaic of ancient concepts and ancient valuations. Arabesques, flourishes, Rococo of scholastic abstractions — still better, namely finer and thinner, than the peasant- and rabble-reality of the European north, still a protest of higher spirituality against the peasant war and rabble-insurrection that has become master of spiritual taste in the north of Europe and that had its ringleader in the great “unspiritual man,” in Martin Luther: — In this sense German philosophy is a piece of counter-Reformation, even Renaissance, at least will to Renaissance, will, to continue in the discovery of antiquity, in the excavation of ancient philosophy, above all of [Page 237] 230 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS the pre-Socratics — of the best-buried of all Greek temples! Perhaps a few centuries later one will judge that all German philosophizing has its genuine dignity in being a step-by-step reclamation of antiquity’s soil, and that every claim to “originality” sounds petty and ridiculous in relation to that higher claim of the Germans to have newly tied the bond that seemed torn, the bond with the Greeks, hitherto the most highly constituted type of “human.” Today we are again approaching all those fundamental forms of interpreting the world that the Greek spirit in Anaximander, Heraclitus, Parmenides, Empedocles, Democritus and Anaxagoras invented — we are becoming more Greek from day to day, at first, as is only fair, in concepts and valuations, as graecofying’ ghosts, so to speak: but someday, hopefully also with our body! Herein lies (and has ever lain) my hope for the German character! 41[5] One opens a female book: — and soon one sighs “another failed cook!” 41[6]” Only the very rarest and most highly evolved individuals achieve the highest and most illustrious human joys in which existence celebrates its own transfiguration, as is only fair: and even these only after they themselves and their ancestors have lived a long and preparatory life aimed at this goal, and without even knowing about this goal. Then an overflowing wealth of manifold forces and simultaneously the most agile power of “willing freely” and masterful commanding dwell lovingly together in a single

human being, the spirit is then just as indigenous and at home in the senses as the senses are at home and indigenous in the spirit; and everything that plays out only in the spirit must also trigger a subtle extraordinary happiness and play in the senses. And likewise in reverse! — consider this reversal in the example of Hafiz; even Goethe, however faintly it shows in him, provides an inkling of this occurrence. It is [Page 238] 41 AUGUST — SEPTEMBER 1885 231 probable that with such perfect and well-evolved human beings ultimately the most sensual tasks are transfigured by a symbolfrenzy of the highest spirituality; they perceive in themselves a kind of deification of the body and they are furthest from the ascetic-philosophy of the proposition “God is a spirit”: whereby it clearly turns out that the ascetic is “the failed human being” who pronounces only a something in itself good, and precisely the judging and condemning something — and pronounces it “God.” From that pinnacle of joy where human beings feel themselves totally and utterly to be a deified form and selfjustification of nature, down to the joy of healthy peasants and healthy semi-human animals: to this entire long tremendous light- and color-scale of happiness the Greeks gave, not without the grateful shudders of someone who is initiated into a mystery, not without great caution and pious silence — the divine name: Dionysus. — What now do all modern humans, the children of a fragmented multifarious sick odd mother know of the scope of Greek happiness, what could they know about it! From where would the slaves of “modern ideas” even take their right to Dionysian festivals! 41[7]” When the Greek body and Greek soul “blossomed,” and not to be sure in conditions of pathological effusion and madness, that mysterious symbol emerged of the highest worldaffirmation and transfiguration of existence attained so far on earth. Here a standard is given according to which everything that has grown since is found to be too brief, too poor, too narrow: — merely pronounce the word “Dionysus” before the best modern names and things, before Goethe, perhaps, or before Beethoven, or before Shakespeare, or before Raphael: and all at once we feel our best things and moments judged. Dionysus is a judge! — Have I been understood? — There is no doubt that the Greeks attempted to interpret the ultimate mysteries “of the fate of the soul” and everything they knew about the education and purification, above all about the unbudgeable rank order [Page 239] 232 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS and value-inequality from human to human, from their Dionysian experiences: here for all things Greek is the great depth, the great silence — one does not know the Greeks as long as the hidden underground entrance still lies here blocked by rubble. Obtrusive scholar-eyes will never see anything of these things, however much scholarship still has to be applied in the service of that excavation — ; precisely here even the noble zeal of such friends of antiquity as Goethe and Winckelmann has something forbidden, almost immodest. Wait and prepare oneself; wait for new sources to open up, prepare oneself in isolation for

strange faces and voices; wash one's soul ever cleaner of the fairground dust and noise of this age; overcome everything Christian through something supra-Christian and not only cast it off — for the Christian doctrine was the counterdoctrine to the Dionysian — ; rediscover the south in oneself and spread out above oneself a bright gleaming mysterious southern sky; reconquer one's southern health and the hidden might of the soul; step by step become more comprehensive, more supranational, more European, more supra-European, more eastern, finally more Greek — for the Greek" was the first great bond and synthesis of everything eastern — : and therewith the very beginning of the European soul, the discovery of our "new world": — whoever lives under such imperatives, who knows what he can encounter some day? Perhaps even — a new day! 4i(8)]° In my early years I declared war on the conditions of German education and dutifully wielded my sword against them: there is no alternative. Away with the women, with the masculine women and sissies too! they know nothing about war and wail themselves half dead over a single drop of shed blood. People have reproached me for earlier having "killed" the aged David Strauss? I will probably have still other human lives on my conscience — but such are the fortunes of war. A thing that is ripe for dying: why artificially nurse, spare and coddle [Page 24] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 17 his own second soul. Plato himself is a man of many back parts and foregrounds.*° 34[67]"! NB. Our age is in its most essential instincts skeptical: nearly all subtler scholars and artists are, even if they do not like to admit it to themselves. Pessimism, of No-saying(.) is only easier for the convenience of the spirit: our humid age with its democratic air is above all convenient. Where the spirit is more delicate it says: "I do not know"; and "I no longer trust myself or anyone" and "I no longer know which way to turn," and "hoping — that is a phrase for the mendacious or for demagogic orators and artists." Skepticism — is the expression of a certain physiological condition as it necessarily arises in a major interbreeding of many races: the many inherited valuations are at war with each other, disrupt each other in their growth. The force that is lost most here is the will: therefore great fear of responsibility, because no one can vouch for himself. Hiding under communities, "one hand covers the other" they say there. Thus a herd-species gets developed: and whoever has a strong commanding and daring will definitely achieves supremacy in such times. 34[68]? There are complaints about how bad philosophers have had it so far: the truth is that at all times the conditions for the education of a powerful crafty daring implacable spirit were more favorable than today. Today the demagogue spirit and also the scholar spirit have favorable conditions. But just look at our artists: whether nearly all of them are not perishing from lack of discipline. They are no longer tyrannized, so they no longer learn to tyrannize themselves either. When was woman as insignificant as today! Everyone is getting weaker because everyone wants to have it convenient.

— I have gone through the harshest school of physical pain: and the consciousness of having kept myself intact despite it, and silently — — [Page 240] 41 AUGUST —SEPTEMBER 1885 233 such a thing? But nothing in the conditions of German education deserves to be spared: that is “ripe.” 4i[9]”

Preface Whoever has the desires of a high and selective soul and only rarely finds Ais table set, Ais nourishment ready, is in no small danger today. Thrown into a noisy, rabble-like age with which he does not want to eat from the same bowl, he could easily perish of hunger and thirst, or, in the event he finally “digs in” after all — of nausea. This was the danger of my youth, an unsatisfied, yearning, solitary youth; and the danger reached its peak when I realized one day which kind of dishes I had ultimately consumed and where the impetuous hunger and thirst of my soul had lured me. It was in summer 1876. At that time, enraged by nausea, I pushed away all the tables at which I had eaten up till then, and I promised myself that I would rather live accidentally and meagerly, rather on grass and weeds and roaming about like an animal, rather not live at all anymore than share my meals with the “theater folk” and the “higher trick riders of the spirit” — I used such harsh expressions back then: — for I seemed to have ended up among sheer Cagliostro and ingenuine people, and I was angry and raging at the fact that I had loved where I should have despised. After I finally became calmer, although definitely not more equitable and conciliatory, I slowly and without rudeness freed myself from my previous “company” and began wandering — sick, sick for many long years. A great, ever greater separation — for philosophical people like to pursue the particular into the universal — a voluntary “alienation” was my sole refreshment in that time: I tested everything to which my heart had generally attached itself up to that point, I turned around the best and most beloved things and looked at their other sides, I did the opposite with everything on which the human art of slander and defamation had so far been practiced most subtly. [Page 241] 236 UNPUBLISHED

FRAGMENTS it and make it stronger, more evil and deeper than it is.” — “Stronger, more evil and deeper?” I asked, startled. “Yes,” he said once more, “stronger, more evil and deeper: also more beautiful” — and at that the god smiled as if he had just uttered a charming compliment. Here we also see immediately: this deity is lacking not only shame — ; and there are generally good reasons to conjecture that in some matters all the gods could learn from us human beings. We are more humane.” And herewith we have arrived and are at the right place: namely at the end. For by now one will have abundantly grasped what it is supposed to be called: Human, All Too Human. And why this book is “a book for free spirits.” 2. What the words Human, All Too Human in this title are supposed to mean I have already made clear — at least for those who have subtle ears. But what in all the world was I thinking back then by “free spirits,” to whom I cast the fishhooks of my book? It seems I desired —company?

41(10)?4 — — — Therefore I cannot sufficiently praise the three fortunate events of my life that at the right time balanced out how I had come to harm through an unsatisfied, yearning and solitary youth. The first was that in my early youth I found a respectable and scholarly occupation that allowed me to make myself at home in the proximity of the Greeks: if one will excuse me this immodest but clear expression. In this manner off to the side and entertained in the best way, I could not easily bring myself to (get) vehemently angry about anything that happens today. In addition to this I was devoted to a philosopher who knew how to valiantly oppose everything in the present, yet without eradicating respect in his pupil through an excess of denial. Finally, ever since I was a child I have been a lover of music and at all times a personal friend of good musicians: all of this together resulted in my having little reason to concern myself about contemporary [Page 242] 41 AUGUST—SEPTEMBER 1885 235 here! Forward, wanderer! There are many seas and lands left for you: who knows whom you must still encounter?" In order to gratefully confess it then: at that time, when I began to study the rule known as "human being," I encountered and my path was crossed by strange and not undangerous spirits, including even very free spirits — and above all one, and this one repeatedly, none other than the god Dionysus himself: — the same one to whom I once, in much younger years, had made a reverential and innocent sacrifice. Perhaps I will once again find enough leisure and quiet to tell my friends everything that I retained from the philosophy of the god Dionysus: in undertones, as is only fair — since we are dealing with many secret things, and much that is uncanny."* But that Dionysus is a philosopher and that gods therefore also philosophize seems to me at least to be an important circumstance worthy of the most cautious communication, which has nothing against it except perhaps that it is not revealed at the right time: for these days people do not like to believe in gods. Perhaps, too, I will have to go further in the frankness of my narrative than is always endearing to the strict habits of my friends' ears. Certainly the god in question went further in our conversations and was always out ahead of me by several steps: he /oves to go far! Indeed, if it were permitted to ascribe beautiful, solemn names of splendor and virtue to him, in keeping with human custom, I would have to greatly extol his explorer and discoverer courage, his honesty, truthfulness and love of wisdom. But such a god does not know what to do with all this venerable junk and splendor. "Keep this," he would say, "for yourself instead and for your kind and whoever else needs it! Z — have no reason to cover my nakedness." As one sees, this kind of deity and philosopher is lacking in shame. Thus he said right away in his first conversation with me: "under certain circumstances I love the human being" — and with this he was alluding to Ariadne —: "it is a pleasant inventive animal without peers on earth, it can even find its way in any labyrinths. I often think about how I can advance [Page 243] 234

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS It was a wicked game: I was often ill because of it — but my resolve stood firm. I “broke my venerating heart” itself and even looked at its broken pieces and their reverse sides — not without all kinds of new joy and curiosity: for one is cruel to the same degree that one is capable of love. Finally I arrived, step by step, at the last challenge of my inner hardness: I put on the best face for my wicked game, laughed at all “pessimism” in me and maliciously defended myself against every conclusion in which illness and loneliness could have played a part: “forward,” I said to myself, “someday you will be healthy, today it suffices for you to feign health! The will to health is already the very best cure!” Then I opened my eyes for the first time — and immediately saw many things and many colors of things, as they are never allowed to be seen by fearful loafers and spirits who are worried about themselves, and have always stayed home. A kind of bird freedom, a kind of bird panorama, a kind of mixture of curiosity and contempt as possessed by anyone who surveys a tremendous multifariousness without being involved — that finally was the newly achieved state with which I persisted for a long time. “A free spirit” and nothing more: thus I felt, thus I called myself at the time; and really I had become the opposite of those who worry about things that do not concern them; the free spirit — I was concerned purely about things that no longer — “worried me.” These were the years of recovery: multifarious years full of colorful and painfully magic events, of which the healthy, the stocky of spirit are permitted to grasp and smell just as little as the sickly, the condemned, those predestined for death and not for life. Back then I had not yet found “myself”: but I was bravely underway to “myself” and tested a thousand things and people I passed along the way, as to whether they belonged to “me” or at least knew something about “me.” What surprises there were! What horrors! What brief little nooks of happiness! What resting in the sun! What tendernesses! And again and again this harsh inner voice that commanded: “away from [Page 244] 41 AUGUST — SEPTEMBER 1885 237 human beings: — for the good musicians are all hermits and outside of time. I was already beyond my twenties when I discovered that I was lacking knowledge of human beings. Is it probable that someone could become a connoisseur of human beings by directing his thoughts neither to honors, nor high office, nor money, nor women, and spending the longest periods of every day by himself? Here there would be ample occasion for mocking if it were not contrary to good taste for the author of a book to abuse its preface for the purpose of mocking himself. Enough, I found reasons, and ever more and better reasons to mistrust my praise as well as my blame; at the same time a vehement and sudden curiosity for “the human being awakened in me: in sum, I resolved to enter a hard and long school. 41(11)” “Thinking” in its primitive state (pre-organic) is the imposing of shapes, as in crystal. — In our thinking the essential element is the ordering of new material into old schemata

(= Procrustean bed), the making-same of what is new. 41[12]26 Conclusion of I. I see new philosophers coming up. If I know you, my friends, you free spirits, then these “coming ones,” beautiful proud birds are flying among you too! — I — — — 41(13)?” — — — But as concerns the above quoted imperative of the German instinct, that commands: “Admit no more Jews! And keep the doors barred to the east!” — then the circumspect calculation of the German Jews themselves should counsel them toward a similar “border-regulation”: their task of growing into the German nature and achieving a more German type of expression and gesture, ultimately of “soul” — for this [Page 245] 238 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS is the pathway, from the outside to the inside, from “appearance” to “reality” — should not be pushed back again and again into the insoluble by the horrific and despicable ugliness of newly immigrating Polish and Russian, Hungarian and Galician Jews. Here is the point where the Jews also for their part have to act, namely “to set borders” for themselves: — the single and last point in which Jewish and German advantage could still balance out to a common advantage: but of course it is time, indeed the highest time! 41(14)”* So far there has been no German culture either. It is no objection to this proposition that there have been great hermits in Germany — Goethe e.g.,; for these had their own culture. But all around them in particular, as around mighty defiant randomly strewn boulders, lay the rest of German nature as their opposite, namely as a soft marshy unstable ground on which every foreign step and stride made its “impression” and created “forms”: “German education” was a thing without character, a nearly limitless elasticity. als)” — I publicly laughed to death a miserable presumptuous moldy book, with which “German education” had become infatuated — well now, on earth one can make a still more dangerous use of one’s laughter! Perhaps in doing this I accidentally “killed” an old man, the old venerable David Strauss, virum optime meritum??? — that’s what people lead me to believe. But such are the fortunes of war; and I want in good conscience to have yet other human lives “on my conscience”! Only away with the women, with the masculine wailing-women and sissies too! They know nothing about war-craft and wail themselves half dead over every “lack of mercy.” In order for something else to begin, here one must first make an end: I certainly hope that here — I have been — understood? But nothing in “German education” deserves to [Page 246] 41 AUGUST —SEPTEMBER 1885 239 be spared anymore: here one must not spare oneself and finally make an end — or something else cannot begin at all 41(16)?! The Germans are deep. the Christian European. the German spirit that unhesitating enthusiast. the demagogues in art. On the Decline of Wagnerianism. How little the German style the Jews Ranke, the embellishing advocate of the fact [Page 247] [42 = Mp XVII 2a. August-September 1885] 4201] The Mirror. An Opportunity for Self-Reflection for Europeans. Latent anarchism. Varieties and causes of world-defamation. II The

Germans. Thoughts on discipline and cultivation. Ulterior motives of logic. The embarrassment of the physicists. II What are “free spirits”? The demagogues in art. The eternal feminine. Morality in Europe. The discipline of willing. On the order of rank. Christ and Dionysus. The historian. I The philosophers of the future. The decline of cheerfulness. On solitude. South and east. A word for musicians. World-interpretation, not world-explanation. (Literature and actor culture.) The “late Wagner.” — [Page 248] 42 AUGUST —SEPTEMBER 1885 241 The genuinely royal calling of the philosopher (according to the expression of Alcuin the Anglo-Saxon): *prava corrigere et recta corroborare et sancta sublimare*. Attempt at a Critique of the Modern Soul. 42[2] Atheism and its causes. Latent atheism. Nationalism and the global economy. On the order of rank and equality. Moral skepticism World defamation and the decrease of cheerfulness North south Music The philosophers The historians The demagogues in art. Woman. The discipline of willing. Nourishment. Reading and literature press. 42[3]*° Human, All Too Human. I Metaphysica If the world had a goal then it must have been reached Using the body as a guide Whoever has pursued the history of any single science What we experience in dream What {separates} us from all Platonic and Leibnizian ways of thinking The human being is a form- and rhythm-constructing creature A thought is in the shape in which it comes “How are synthetic judgments a priori What distinguishes me most thoroughly from the metaphysicians, [Page 249] 242 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS Truth: this describes within The logical thinking, of which logic speaks There are truths that are best {}° by mediocre minds Conclusion: In what strange simplification! The new Oedipus. Appearance, as I understand it. Human, All Too Human II Section Moralia “Our highest insights must — and should — like follies, indeed like crimes” “Insofar as at all times, as long as humans have existed, herds also” “Moralities are the main method” “One is still offended, if someone, “The old theological problem of faith and of knowledge” “Crudeness. — Words are musical notes for concepts” “Nothing more miserable than moralistic literature etc.” “The will. — In each will there is a plurality “The diversity of human beings is revealed not only in the diversity of their tablets of good” “At bottom morality is inimically disposed toward science” Human, All Too Human. Religiosa. “The human soul and its limits” “The philosophers will also {use} religions” “In the Jewish Old Testament — ” “The English, dark, sensual” Conclusion “On the highest and most illustrious human joys” Human, All Too Human. 4 Art On the whole I agree more with the artists: pessimism. Conclusion: Against R. Wagner. On the decline of Wagnerianism. — How little the German style {corresponds} with the sound Human, All Too Human. 5. Higher Culture. German philosophy as romanticism [Page 25] 18 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 34[69] The subtlest minds of the previous century, Hume and Galiani, all entrusted with service to the state: likewise

Stendhal Tocqueville. 34[70] Hume challenges (to use Kant's words*3) reason to account for and answer with what right it thinks to itself: that something could be constituted in such a way that, when it is posited, something different therefore must necessarily also be posited, for that is what the concept of cause says. He proved irrefutably that it is entirely impossible for reason to think such a connection a priori and from concepts etc. — But the folly was in asking for reasons for the right to the justification. He did the very deed that he wanted to test.*4 34[71] The Jie of the educator e.g., in Kant's categorical imperative. "Could God be a deceiver after all, despite Descartes?" 34[72] NB. Truthful, morally rigorous and ugly belong together: Christianity sensed this well. A beautiful human being can be neither truthful, nor kind, only as an exception. 34173] What separates us from Kant just as from Plato and Leibniz: we believe only in becoming, also in matters of spirit, we are historical through and through. This is the great reversal. Lamarck and Hegel — Darwin is only an aftereffect. The manner of thinking of Heraclitus and Empedocles has risen again. Even Kant did not overcome the contradictio in adjecto "pure spirit": but we did. 34[74]*° The human horizon. Philosophers can be perceived as those who make the most extreme effort to test how far humanity can [Page 250] 42 AUGUST — SEPTEMBER 1885 243 People call the Germans profound. Wagner and Paris Even today the finest culture is Victor Hugo "The demagogues of culture Kant's influence in Europe Supposing one were to think of a philosopher as a great educator On conviction and justice (penultimate) In Relations with Others. When the philosophers {mingle} with the homines' Human, All Too Human. Woman and child. The greater sensuality One cannot think highly enough of women The decline of grace. — Human, All Too Human. State. Socialism is the ultimate Over all these national wars, new empires There is a nobility of blood That unhesitating enthusiast The Germans, {compared} to their Germanic ancestors The German Jews. — The good Europeans. The Germans have not yet been anything, for they are becoming something Human, All Too Human. By oneself alone. — The danger with extraordinary spirits A person who strives for greatness — That many speak of things with respect to which — The hermit, the higher philosophical human being. I followed by: "Freethinker" Third to last II "the free spirit" and solitude III 2 (At the end) The strong spirit IV Conclusion: In Genoa: Oh my friends, do you understand this "Nevertheless"? — — [Page 251] 244 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 42[4]° 1 The knowing one 2 Beyond what is good and evil? 3 New fables of God 4 Man and woman 5 Friend, Enemy and solitude 42[5]° Alone or in twos — 6, 13, 14, 24, 36, 48 Victims — 19, 18 Contempt for woman — 20, I, 17, 23, 37 Not too many words — 22, 15 Child man woman — 28 The creators — 29, 30 Against self-knowledge — 38, 45 In order to be loved — 46 Purposes — 57 Herd — 62 Marriage — 60, 53, 18, 17 Devil God — 47 Time and future — 76, 102 42[6]°! P. 1. There is no common-

good: — this word contradicts itself, for whatever can be common must always be of common value therefore not be good. 1 Dogmatists. Plato and the “pure spirit.” the magnificent tension through the dogmatists. Skeptics. The commanders rare. In the end the most mediocre rule in philosophy! Where does the will still exist? 3 The critics: Does German philosophy belong in the critical or the skeptical movement? Kant. No, it is a countermovement, at N [Page 252] 42 AUGUST — SEPTEMBER 1885 245 bottom a theological one. “without a passionate enjoyment.” 4 The English and philosophy, entirely unsuited for the moralistic “hunt.” The French. Richard Wagner. 5 Herd-morality. Christianity makes small (the) Old Testament. Socialism. Free thinkers. “Enlightenment” 6 The philosopher as the experimenter of new possibilities the value of immorality for upbringing. his cruelty his solitude. Teichm(iiller) 7 My antecedents. On my Unfashionable Observations a word about pessimism. a word about artists: the Dionysian. the shaping of the soul of Europe. significance of the Greeks, their discovery the historical sense 8 The Dionysian. 42[7]!? — the spitting image of my hallucinations — did the trees already look green 50 thousand years ago? — prior to logic, temporally speaking, lies the production of identical cases, assimilation — memory in the organic sequence — “innate” ideas — hypocrisy would be eliminated if it were not funny to look at. Not gods according to Epicurus, but according to Homer: or like Galiani — the mathematicians who continue deducing until the atom becomes useful to them! But h(umans) have always done it this way, in a cruder form. What does reality matter before it is useful for our house! [Page 253] 246 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 42[8]!° Yes, the philosophy of right! This is a science which, like all moral sciences, is not even in diapers yet! E.g., the oldest meaning of punishment has yet to be recognized, not even among jurists who imagine themselves to be freethinking — it is completely unknown: and as long as jurisprudence fails to establish itself on new ground, namely in history and comparative studies of peoples, it will remain trapped in dreary battles between thoroughly false abstractions that fancy themselves these days to be “philosophy of right” and that are completely derived from the contemporary h(uman being). Yet this contemporary h(uman being) is such a convoluted web, even in regard to its leg(al) valuations, that it allows for the most varied interpretations. [Page 254] [43 = Z I 2c. Autumn 1885] 431]! Draft. The first problem is: how deeply does the “will to truth” go into things? If one were to measure the entire value of ignorance connected with the means for preservation of life, likewise the value of simplifications generally and the value of regulative fictions, e.g., of the logical kind, if one were to consider above all the value of interpretations, and to what extent it is a matter not of “it is” but “it means” — — — then one arrives at this solution: the “will to truth” develops in the service of the “will to power”: on close scrutiny its actual task is helping a certain kind of untruth to victory and to duration, taking a

coherent whole of falsifications as the basis for the preservation of a certain kind of life. Problem: how deep down does the will to goodness go into the heart of things. One sees the opposite of this everywhere, in plants and animals: Indifference or harshness or cruelty. “Justice” “punishment.” The development of cruelty. Solution: Sympathy only exists in social constructs (to which the human body belongs, whose living individual beings sympathize with one another) as the consequence of the fact that one greater whole wants to preserve itself against another whole, and again because in the overall economy of the world, where there is no possibility of perishing and loss, goodness would (be) a superfluous principle. [Page 255] 248 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS Problem: how deeply reason reaches into the ground of things. According to a critique of ends and means (— no factual relationship, but always one that only gets interpreted into it), the character of squandering, of derangement is normal (in the) overall economy. “Intelligence” appears as a specific form of unreason, nearly as its most malicious caricature. Problem: how far does the “will to beauty” reach. Ruthless development of forms: the most beautiful are only the strongest: as the triumphant they maintain themselves firmly, and take pleasure in their type, reproduction. (Plato’s belief that even philosophy is a kind of sublime sexual and reproductive drive.) Hence the things that we have so far valued most highly: as the “true,” “good,” “reasonable,” “beautiful,” prove to be isolated cases of the converse powers — I point my finger at this tremendous perspectival falsification, by virtue of which the species human being asserts itself. It is its condition of life that it enjoys itself this way (the human being takes joy in the means of its preservation: and they include that the human being does not want to let itself be deceived, that humans mutually help each other, (are) prepared to understand one another; that on the whole the successful types know how to live at the expense of the failed). In all of this the will to power expresses itself, with its unhesitating readiness to seize the means of deception: a malicious pleasure is conceivable, that a god senses when looking at a human being admiring itself. Therefore: the will to power. Consequence: if this idea is hostile to us, why do we give in to it? Bring on the beautiful phantoms! Let us be deceivers and embellishers of humanity! Fact, what actually a philosopher is. 43[2]? Misunderstanding of logic: it explains nothing, on the contrary Misunderstanding of historical development: succession is a description Superficiality of our causality-sense. [Page 256] 43 AUTUMN 1885 249 “Knowledge” — to what extent impossible in a world of becoming? The organic world represents a perspectival sphere. Knowability of the world — in itself an immodesty for human beings. Dissolution of the instincts — transformation into formulas and formula human beings. Against naturalism and mechanism. The “calculability” of the world, whether it is desirable? with this even the creative act would be “calculable”? Mechanics a kind of ideal, as regulative method — nothing more.

Mockery of the idealists who believe “truth” to be where they feel “good” or “elevated.” Classical: Renan, quoted by Bourget. Denial of empty space and reduction of mechanics to tyranny of the eye and touch. Denial of the actio in distans.> Against pressure and thrust. The shape of the world as cause of its cycle process. Not sphere! Force continual. Against Laplace-Kant. Battle of the atoms, as of individuals, but with a certain difference in strength from two atoms one will form, and from two individuals one. Likewise inversely from one two will form if the inner state brings about a disgregation of the power-center. — Therefore against the absolute concept “atom” and “individual”! The atom fights for its duration, but other atoms attack it in order to increase their strength. Both processes: that of disintegration and that of compression to be understood as effects of the will to power. Down to its tiniest fragments it has the will to compress. But it is forced, in order to compress itself anywhere, to dilute itself at another spot etc. Planetary bodies and atoms only different in magnitude, but same laws. [Page 257] 250 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 43[3] The Germans, in whose Germanic ancestors no Tacitus was able to praise the spirit, or even only a pleasure in spirituality, perhaps an *argute loqui*“ in addition have done everything possible throughout many centuries to make themselves stupid; and a malicious God who was hostile to Germans — possibly in fear of their predestined atheism and twilight of the gods? — ruled over them and endowed them exclusively with the inclinations that a people uses to shut the doors to even the arrival of the spirit: e.g., by commanding them to sweat in overheated beds, to crouch in stuffy narrow rooms, to choose as their favorite foods nothing but undigestible dishes like dumplings and heavy fatty broths, above all to drink until they fell down: so that going to sleep and being drunk were for a long time neighboring concepts of a German mind. One is almost tempted to believe that, if there were something like “German spirit” after all, it was only made possible through de-Germanification, I mean through mixing with foreign blood. Who keeps a ledger of everything that the Slavs or the Celts or the Jews are owed for the spiritualization of Germany! But the blood-mixing itself may have been most important, in that it planted different instincts in the same p(erson) and not always only “two but instead twenty souls” in a single breast,’ that tremendous bloodcorruption of the race, which has no equal in Europe and has made of the German an all-comprehending, all-sympathizing and accommodating people of the middle, of mediation — a ferment-race in whom henceforth “no thing is impossible.” If one checks the history of the German soul, one grasps(, how) these inwardly imbalanced, multifaceted, multifarious h(uman beings) became outwardly weak, servile, comfortable, clumsy, inwardly a playground of spiritual temptations and struggles: how finally at least a kind of stirring peasant- and preacher-spirit sprang up (Luther is the most beautiful example of this, he who waged the peasant war of the spirit against the “superior human beings” of the

Renaissance —), how this peasant- and preacherspirit later transformed itself into the aggressive, cutting and [Page 258] 43 AUTUMN 1885 251 biting citizen- and critic-spirit — Lessing is again the most beautiful example of this, he who waged a “citizens’ war,” the war of the German bourgeois against the aristocratic spirit of French culture: Lessing against Corneille, Lessing the advocate of Diderot): until finally our last double-type of the ever-developing spirit, Goethe and Hegel, manifested the all-encompassing boa constrictor “spirit in itself” and its ferment-nature, the cosmoand theo-political all-accessibility of the German, the superiority of his abstractions, the clever suppleness of his accommodating historicizing: its last and most noble variation, that of a mandarin-esque superiority and “beyondness” — — — — all of Europe sank to its knees in admiration of it — — of course to the same extent the complete lack of limits, of measure in the Greek sense, of any sense of “style,” of a genuine content — I mean of new valuations, value-creations. Nonetheless: compared to this last great European remarkable event, this “German spirit,” the “German empire” that is being taken so seriously at the moment is no object of serious interest, at least in the eyes of a philosopher. Why in all the world a new empire if it does not rest on a new idea, or at least on a new stupidity? But once again this old stupidity — equal political rights, representation of the people, parliamentarianism, newspapers as the foundation of a state — once again the idiocy-producing European sickness of constant politicizing expanded to one more great people: what new things would a ph(ilosopher) have to learn here — or even to despise! — [Page 259] [44 = Mp XVII 2b. Autumn 1885] 44lr] The chapters. On Interpretation. On the Order of Rank. The Paths to the Saint. The Eternal Recurrence. The Superstition of the Critical Philosophers. Critique of Pascal: he already has the Christian-moral interpretations in the nature of human beings and thinks he grasps the “facts.” Sainte-Beuve too. 44[2] Nothing has happened since Pascal, the German philosophers do not come into consideration compared to him. 44[3] The Germans have no prose that rings and leaps. 44[4] The classical prose of the French of 1648: what has to come together. 44[5] The absence of moral) cultivation; h(umans) have been allowed to grow. Perhaps the h(umans) of Port-Royal are like artificial gardens. [Page 26] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 19 elevate itself, Plato especially: how far its force reaches. But they do it as individuals; perhaps the instinct of the Caesar(s), the founders of states etc. was greater, those who think about how far humanity can be driven in terms of development and under “favorable conditions.” But they did not sufficiently understand what “favorable conditions” are. Big question: where so far the plant “human being”? has grown most magnificently. For this the comparative study of history is necessary. 34[75] It is remarkable how the Stoics and almost all philosophers have no gaze for the distance. And then once more the stupidity of the socialists who always represent only the needs of the herd. 34[76] To put the

mechanistic idea first as the regulative principle of method. Not as the best proven worldview, but as the one which makes necessary the greatest severity and rigor and does the most to set aside all sentimentality. Simultaneously a test of physical and psychic prosperity: failed weak-willed races are destroyed by it, through sensuality or through melancholy or, like the Indians, through both. 34177] Great praise of Christianity as the genuine erd religion. 34[78] Noon and Eternity. 1. Free for “true” and “untrue” 2. free for “good” and “evil” 3. free for “beautiful” and “ugly” 4. the superior human being as the mightier, and the attempts so far: “it is the right time.” 5. the hammer — a danger on which human beings can be smashed [Page 260] 44 AUTUMN 1885 253 Authority is lacking. Moderation within calm horizons is lacking; — infinity has been made into a kind of drunkenness. Subtlety in judgment is lacking. A chaos of contradictory valuations rules. 44(6) What is this then, this struggle of the Christian “against nature”? We will certainly not let ourselves be deceived by his words and interpretations! It is nature against something that is nature. For many fear, disgust for some, a certain spirituality for others, love for an ideal without flesh and desire, for the highest types an “extract of nature” — the latter want to be like their ideal. It goes without saying that humiliation instead of a sense of self, fearful caution of desires, separation from the ordinary duties (whereby a higher sense of rank is again created) the stirring up of a constant struggle for tremendous things, the habit of emotional effusion — it all composes one type: in it irritability of an atrophying body predominates, but nervousness and its inspiration are interpreted otherwise. The taste of this kind of character focuses 1) on hair-splitting 2) on the flowery 3) on extreme emotions. — The natural inclinations do indeed satisfy themselves, but under a new form of interpretation e.g., as “justification before God,” “feeling of redemption in grace” (— every undeniable feeling of well-being is interpreted this way! —) pride, lust etc. — General problem: what becomes of the human being who slanders the natural in himself and renounces and stunts it in practice? In fact the Christian proves to be an exaggerated form of self-mastery: in order to control his desires, he appears to need to annihilate or crucify them. —* The Epicurean kind of Christian and the Stoic kind — to the former belongs Francois de Sales, to the latter Pascal Triumph of Epicurus — but precisely this kind of human being is hard to understand and must be poorly understood. The Stoic kind (which needs to fight and consequently unduly treasures the value of the fighter —) always slanders the “Epicurean”! [Page 261] 254 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 4417] Graeco-Roman antiquity needed a tyrannical and exaggerating morality of anti-nature; the Teutons likewise, in a different respect. Our contemporary kind of human being actually dispenses with rigor and strict discipline; the danger in this is not great because this kind of human being is weaker than earlier kinds and on the other hand because the unconscious disciplinarians (like industriousness,

ambition to get ahead, bourgeois respectability) function very inhibitably and hold one in check. — But ow people from the age of Pascal had to be held together! Superfluous Christianity: where no extreme means are necessary anymore! There everything becomes false, and every word, every Christian perspective a tartuffery and cajoling. 44[8] The New Japan. I read with much malice of ulterior motives what a German anarchist {means} by the notion “free society” — — — “Free society” — all features as grotesque word- and colorfinery of a small kind of herd animal. “Justice” and the morality of equal rights — the tartuffery of moral predicates. “the press,” its idealization. “the abolition of the worker” “the pre-Aryan race is breaking through”: and generally the oldest kinds of society the decline of woman the Jews as ruling race. Noble and vulgar culture. the scholar overestimated: and a triumphing more loving and masterful fullness of heart — how I saw all of this, perhaps without love, but surely also without scorn, and what probably causes amazement therefore — with the curiosity of a child that stands before the most colorful and ornamental of all peep shows. — — — [Page 262] 44 AUTUMN 1885 255 44lo]? Consider how all suffering forces a h(uman being) back upon himself, damage, supposing it makes smarter certainly to the same degree also makes worse (narrow, petty, suspicious, loveless — — — For their number is always small: but the others, the suffering, have nothing that heals them to that degree from the negative consequences of much suffering and — — — [Page 263] asi) 4s(2)! asis)? [45 = W I 6b. Autumn 1885] Discipline of the Heart. Prince Vogelfrei Songs and Thoughts. By Friedrich Nietzsche. Dedication and Closing Refrain? Songs and Thoughts Of Prince Vogelfrei By Friedrich Nietzsche. Misfortune overtakes the fugitive — whether As golden grief of the impoverished hand, As sadness of the eternally bestowing: Misfortune captures the fugitive — whether [Page 264] 45 AUTUMN 1885 257 Unconcerned and not mindful of himself He tossed the pearls away That forces the conquered down That turns every pride to tears: Dishonest constellation, You tossed the pearls into the sand — The sea gulped them in its throat! What does life owe the squanderer 45[6] How one gets beyond self-destruction. The harpies. Breaking free. For the history of the “free spirit.” Description of the free spirits. 2) cheerfulness 3) masks 4) nobility. the woman question Artist-pessimism. 4s(71° Day is fading, joy and light turn yellowy, The noon hour is far. How much longer? Then come the moon and stars And wind and frost: no lingering for me, Like fruit that a breeze breaks from the tree [Page 265] Prefatory Note by Mazzino Montinari to KSA Volume 12 Volumes 12 and 13 of the Kritische Studienausgabe {CW 16 [in part], 17, and 18} together contain Nietzsche’s unpublished fragments from autumn 1885 to the beginning of January 1889. The fragments are preserved in twenty-two handwritten manuscripts, more specifically fifteen larger booklets, three notebooks, and four folders. The principles according to which the publication of Nietzsche’s

unpublished fragments proceed can be found in the prefatory note to CW 10, part of which is reproduced in the following six paragraphs. The fragments from the Nachlass are published according to strictly chronological principles; the editors have refrained from any systematic arrangement. Accordingly, the manuscripts are published in the sequence corresponding to their date of origin. Every single page of a manuscript is reproduced either according to the arrangement of the pages made by Nietzsche himself or according to the sequence of pages that can be deduced with certainty on the basis of his transcriptional habits (e.g., his habit of writing in booklets from back to front). If both of these indications are lacking, then the archival numeration of the pages is taken as valid. The principle that the manuscripts are published individually is subordinated to the temporal sequence when a manuscript contains layers from different times; in this case the individual layers are published separately. The orthography and punctuation of [Page 266] PREFATORY NOTE TO VOLUME I 259 the manuscripts are maintained in principle; unavoidable editorial interventions are indicated in the apparatus of KSA {and translated in this volume}. The consecutive numbering of the manuscripts or of their layers derives from the editors; it is begun anew within each chronological section for the corresponding groups of Nachlass fragments. Every manuscript or every layer of a manuscript is supplied with a number corresponding to the chronological sequence; the fragments within a manuscript or within the layer of a manuscript are likewise numbered consecutively, so that next to the number indicating the manuscript or the layer of a manuscript is found another number in square brackets that indicates the sequence of the fragments as this can be determined in each case. Words underlined by Nietzsche only once are printed in italics; ones underlined twice or more are printed in bold. Angle brackets () indicate supplements by the editors. Square brackets [] indicate titles in the Nachlass text that are provided by the editors. {Curly brackets { } indicate supplements by the translator or CW editors.} The following symbols are also used in the Nachlass text: [—] an illegible word; [— —] two illegible words; [— — —] three or more illegible words; — — — incomplete sentence; [+] lacuna in the manuscript. The classifications for Nietzsche's manuscripts introduced by Hans-Joachim Mette have been retained.!! Let the following be noted with respect to volumes 12 and 13 of KSA {volumes 16, 17, and 18 of CW}: these volumes take on a special meaning because — through their complete and manuscript-faithful reproduction of all fragments, drafts, plans, and titles from autumn 1885 until the end of Nietzsche's productivity in the beginning of 1889 — they constitute the foundation for a conclusive solution to the much-discussed problem of 1. Cf. Sachlicher Vorbericht zur Gesamtausgabe der Werke Friedrich Nietzsches, 1:xxxi —cxxvi, of the interrupted complete historical critical edition (Munich: Beck, 1933—40). [Page 267] 260 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS Nietzsche's alleged

philosophical main work with the title *The Will to Power*. Read in their chronological sequence, the fragments yield a precise, almost seamless representation of his productivity and his literary intentions from autumn 1885 to the beginning of January 1889. They clearly reveal that and why the compilation of *The Will to Power* arranged by Peter Gast and Elisabeth Férster-Nietzsche, included in previously published editions of Nietzsche, is editorially untenable and objectively questionable in the extreme. The commentary (KSA 14 [pp. 383 — 400, {translated in CW}]) will explain this in detail and prove that and how Nietzsche changed his literary plans in the course of the years, until finally at the end of August 1888 he dispensed entirely with the publication of a work under the title *The Will to Power: Attempt at a Revaluation of All Values*. It is the achievement of Karl Schlechta to have elevated to a principal editorial requirement the publication of the unpublished notes in chronological sequence.” Yet it is precisely this requirement that he did not fulfill in his edition of Nietzsche’s unpublished notes from the so-called revaluation period, because he merely published the exact same material of the traditional *Will to Power* in a (seeming) chronological sequence. In other words: Schlechta unintentionally validated the content of the selection of Peter Gast and Elisabeth Férster-Nietzsche from the mass of unpublished fragments from the 1880s. 2. Cf. Friedrich Nietzsche, *Werke in drei Banden* (Munich{: Carl Hanser,} 1954-56), 3:1393ff. [Page 268] [1 = N VII 2b. Autumn 1885—Spring 1886] [x]! Really I should have around me a circle of deep and tender human beings who would protect me somewhat from myself and would also know how to cheer me up: because for someone who thinks such things as I must think, the danger is always very near that he will destroy himself. 1[2]? Let no one believe that a person lands accidentally and on both feet one day in such a robust state of the soul as seen in the testimony or metaphor of the dance song that was just concluded. Before one learns to dance in this manner one must have first learned thoroughly to walk and run, and even to stand on one’s own legs is something for which, it seems to me, only a few are ever predestined. In the period when one first dares to go forth on his own limbs and without leading-strings and railings, in the periods of the first youthful strength and all the charms of one’s own spring time, one is most endangered and often walks timidly, hesitatingly, like an escapee, like an exile, with a trembling conscience and with a bizarre mistrust of his path: — when the youthful freedom of the spirit is like a wine [Page 269] 262

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS [3] The Mirror. Lack of a dominating way of thinking. The actors. Gleba.4 The new shamelessness (that of the mediocre, e.g., the English, also of women who write) The will to prejudice (nations, parties etc. Latent Buddhism. The lack of solitude (and consequently of good company) Alcohol, book and music and other stimulants. The philosophers of the future. The ruling caste and anarchism. The curious difficulties of the unusual one who

is disturbed by his plebeian modesty. Lack of character-upbringing. Lack of higher monasteries Gradual restriction of people's rights. [4] — The doctrine of opposites (good, evil etc.) has value as an educational standard, because it makes people take sides. —the most powerful, and dangerous passions of humanity, from which it is most easily ruined, have been outlawed so thoroughly that the most powerful human beings themselves have become impossible or would have to feel themselves to be evil, to be “harmful and forbidden.” This loss is great, but so far it has been necessary: now that a quantum of counterforces has been cultivated through temporary suppression of those passions (of lust to rule, joy in transformation and deception) their unleashing is again possible: they will no longer have their old wildness. We allow ourselves tame barbarism: just look at our artists and politicians? —The synthesis of opposites and counter-drives a sign of the total strength of a human being: how much can it control? —A new concept of holiness: Plato's naiveté — no longer the opposite of those drives branded heretical in the foreground [Page 27] 20 UNPUBLISHED

FRAGMENTS 34[79] Kant believed, with his table of categories in hand, “this is the most difficult task that could ever be undertaken for the benefit of metaphysics.”^{oo} — we had better not misunderstand where he placed his pride. 34[80] Crudeness and delicatessen! at the same time in Petronius, in Horace too: what I like best. It belongs to Greek taste. Homer was too crude for the people around La Rochefoucauld, they could not enjoy the trivial. They held on to a certain high perception among themselves, as now many Germans, and despise(d) themselves if perhaps a pleasure in the lower spheres stir(red) in them. Aristophanes is the opposite: nihil human'? — is ancient. 34[81] To place at the top: the instincts also have become, they prove not(hing) for the supersensual, not even for what is animal, not even for what is typically human. That the spirit has become and is still becoming, that among countless kinds of concluding and judging somehow the one most familiar to us now is most useful to us and has been inherited because the individuals who think in this manner had better chances: that nothing about “true” and “untrue” is proven by this, — — — 34[82]” — Anti-Kant. “Faculty, instinct, heredity, habit” today whoever seeks to explain something using such words must be modest and moreover poorly trained. But it raged at the end of the previous century. Galiani explained everything on the basis of habits and instincts.^{o4} Hume explained the sense of causality on the basis of habit; Kant said with great calm: “it is a faculty.”[®] Everyone was happy, especially as he had also discovered a [Page 270] I]

AUTUMN I—SPRING 1886 263 —To be demonstrated, to what extent the Greek religion was higher than the Jewish-Christian. The latter triumphed because the Greek religion itself had degenerated (had regressed).^o Goal: the sanctification of the most powerful terrible and best-discredited forces, or to say it old-fashionedly: the deification of the devil [5] — I measure according to how

far a human being, a people can unleash the most terrible drives in himself and turn them to his salvation, without perishing from them: on the contrary for his fruitfulness in deeds and works — the interpretation of all mishaps as effects of unreconciled spirits is what has so far driven the great masses to religious cults. Even the higher moral life, that of the saint, has been invented only as one of the means of satisfying unreconciled spirits. — the interpretation of our experiences as providential hints of a kindly, educating divinity, even of our mishaps: — Development of the fatherly concept of God, proceeding from the patriarchal family. — the absolute corruption of humanity, the unfreedom for goodness and consequently the interpretation of all our actions with the interpretation of bad conscience: finally mercy. Miracleact. Sudden reversal. Paul, Augustine, Luther — the barbarization of Christianity by the Teutons: the intermediate beings, and the abundance of cults of atonement, in brief the pre-Christian standpoint returns. Likewise the composition-system. — Luther restores the basic logic of Christianity, the impossibility of morality and consequently of self-satisfaction, the necessity of mercy and consequently of miracles and also predestination. At bottom an admission of being overcome and an outbreak of self-contempt. [Page 271] 264 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS — “it is impossible to pay one’s debts,” outbreaks of salvation craving and the cults and mysteries. “It is impossible to rid oneself of sins” Outbreak of the Christianity of Paul Augustine and Luther. Formerly the occasion to become religious was external misfortune; later the inner feeling of misfortune, being unredeemed, fear, uncertainty. What appears to distinguish Christ and Buddha: it appears to be inner happiness that would make them religious 1[6] — the feeling of belonging to the higher order of rank is dominating in the moral feeling: it is the self-testimony of the higher caste whose actions and conditions afterwards pass again as the sign for a disposition with which one belongs in that caste or should belong in it — 1[7]’ — at first the moral feeling is developed with respect to human beings (classes above all!), only later is it translated to actions and character traits. The pathos of distance is in the innermost ground of that feeling. 1[8] — the unknowing state of human beings and their nonreflecting make for the fact that individual attribution is only made later on. One feels oneself too unfree, unspiritual, swept away by sudden drives, to think of oneself in any other way than with respect to nature: in us, too, demons are active. i[9]8 — Human, all too human. One cannot reflect on morality without involuntarily becoming morally occupied and indicating one’s morality. Thus I worked at the time on that refinement of morality that already perceives “reward” and “punishment” as “immoral” and no longer knows how to interpret the concept “justice” as “affectionate understanding,’ at bottom approval. In this perhaps there is weakness, perhaps dissipation, perhaps also — — [Page 272] 1 AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 265 1[10]? — “punishment” develops in the narrowest space, as reaction of the

powerful, of the lord of the house, as expression of his wrath toward the disrespect of his command and prohibition. — Before the morality of custom (whose canon wants “everything traditional should be honored”) stands the morality of the ruling person (whose canon wants that “the commander alone should be honored”) The pathos of distance, the feeling of rank differentiation lies at the ultimate bottom of all morality. 1i] — “Soul” ultimately as “concept of the subject” 11[12] — If things are unknown, then so too is the human being. Whar’s the use of praising and blaming here! 1(13] — I do not grasp how one can be a theologian. I do not wish to think ill of such human beings, who are not after all just knowledge-machines [14] — Every action of which a human being is not capable is misunderstood by him. It is distinguishing to always be misunderstood with one’s actions. Then it is also necessary and no excuse for becoming embittered. [15] — It is not unselfish when I prefer to reflect upon causality instead of the lawsuit against my publisher;® my gain and my enjoyment lie in the direction of knowledge, precisely there my tension, restlessness, passion have been active longest. 1[16] Thoughts are actions [Page 273] 266 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 1[17] — how we have relearned in fifty years! The whole of Romanticism with its belief in the “folk” has been refuted! No Homeric writing as folk-poetry! No deification of the great powers of nature! No inference from linguistic-affinity to racial-affinity! No “intellectual intuition”!! of the supersensual! No truth veiled in religion! 1[18] — The problem of truthfulness is entirely new. I am amazed: In this we regard such natures as Bismarck as guilty out of negligence, those like Richard Wagner out of lack of modesty, we would condemn Plato with his pia fraus,!? Kant on account of the deduction of his categorical imperative, whereas faith certainly did not come to him on this path 1[19] — Finally doubt also turns against itself: doubt about doubt. And the question of the justification of truthfulness and its scope stands there — 1[20] — All our conscious motives are surface phenomena: behind them stands the struggle of our drives and conditions, the struggle for power.’? 1[21] — That this melody sounds beautiful is not imparted to children by authority a(nd) instruction; no more so than the pleasant feeling at the sight of an honorable human being. Valuations are innate, despite Locke!, inherited; to be sure, they develop more strongly and beautifully when the people who protect and love us at the same time share the same valuations. What agony for a child to always posit his good and evil in contrast to his mother and to be scorned and despised wherever he venerates! [Page 274] 1 AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 267 1[22] — How manifold is that which we perceive as moral feeling: in it are veneration, fear, being touched as if by something holy and mysterious, in it speaks something that commands, that takes itself to be more important than we are; something that elevates, enflames or makes us calm and deep. Our moral feeling is a synthesis, a simultaneous-resounding of all dominating and

subservient feelings that reigned in the history of our ancestors 1[23] — To the credit of the present. Health is promoted, ascetic world-renouncing ways of thinking (with their will to sickness) scarcely comprehended. Everything possible is valid and allowed to be valid and acknowledged, moist mild air in which every kind of plant grows. It is paradise for all petty luxurious vegetation 1[24] — Soul and breath and existence equated to *esse*. What lives is being: there is no further being. r[25]° — “The good people are all weak: they are good because they are not strong enough to be evil” said the Latuka chief Comorro to Baker.° 1[26]!” *gin* is Arabic and means *spiritus*? (= *g’inn*) 1 [27] “For the faint-hearted there is no misfortune” one says in Russian” 1[28] — all movements are to be understood as gestures, as a kind of language through which forces understand one another. In the [Page 275] 268 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS inorganic world misunderstanding is lacking, communication appears perfect. In the organic world error begins. “Things” “substances” properties, activ-“ities” — all this should not be carried into the inorganic world! They are the specific errors by virtue of which organisms live. Problem of the possibility of “error”? The contrast is not “false” and “true,” but “abbreviations of the signs” as opposed to the signs themselves. What is essential is: the formation of forms that represent many movements, the invention of signs for entire varieties of signs. — all movements are signs of an inner occurrence; and every inner occurrence expresses itself in such changes of forms. Thinking is not yet inner occurrence itself, but likewise only a sign language for the power equalization of affects.”! 1[29] — the anthropomorphizing of nature — interpretation according to us. [30] A. Psychological point of departure: — our thinking and valuations are only an expression for cravings that reign behind them. — the cravings become more and more specialized: their unity is the will to power (to apply the expression of the strongest of all drives that has so far directed all organic development) — Reduction of all organic basic functions to the will to power — question, whether it is not likewise the mobile? in the inorganic world? For in the mechanistic worldinterpretation a mobile is still needed. — “law of nature”: as a formula for the unconditional production of power-relations and degrees. — mechanical motion is only a means of expression of an inner occurrence. — “cause and effect” [Page 276] I AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 269 1[31] — struggle as the means of equilibrium 1[32]*4 — the assumption of atoms is only a consequence of the concept of subject and substance: somewhere there must be “a thing” from which the activity proceeds. The atom is the last descendant of the concept of the soul. 1[33]” — the most terrible and thorough yearning of humanity, its drive for power — one calls this drive “freedom” — must be held in check for the longest time. This is why ethics to date, with its unconscious instincts of education and cultivation, has been intent upon keeping the greed for power in check: it disparages the tyrannical

individual and underscores the herdpower instinct with its glorification of communal welfare and love of the fatherland. 1[34] — According to nature the strengths of humankind should develop in such a sequence that the undangerous ones are developed (praised, approved) first off, that conversely the strongest ones remain slandered and branded longest as heretics. 1[35]”° The Will to Power. Attempt at a New Interpretation of all Events. By Friedrich Nietzsche. 1[36] the world of thought only a second degree of the world of appearance — [Page 277] 270 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 1[37] — movements are not “effected” by a “cause”: that would be the old soul-concept once more! — they are the will itself, but not entirely and completely! 1[38] NB. The belief in causality goes back to the belief that it is I who effects, to the division of the “soul” from its activity. Therefore an ancient superstition! 1[39] The tracing back of an effect to a cause is: back to a subject. All changes are regarded as produced by subjects. 1[40] — the current stage of morality demands a) no punishment! 2) no reward — 3) no servility 4) no pia fraus! no retaliation! 1[41] — we no longer bear the sight of them, consequently we do away with slaves 1[42]*” It is a favorite expression of the indolent and those without conscience tout comprendre cest tout pardonner??? it is also a stupidity. Oh if one always had to wait first for the “comprendre”: it seems to me that one would then too seldom arrive at forgiving! And in the end, why should one forgive precisely if one had understood? Supposing I understood completely and thoroughly why this proposition bothers me, should I therefore not be allowed to cross it out? — There are enough cases where one crosses out a person because one has understood him. [Page 278] I AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 271 [43] — the concept “change” already posits the subject in advance, the soul as substance 1[44] — the offense that one takes at the doctrine “of the unfreedom of will” is this: it seems as though it were claiming “you do what you do not voluntarily but involuntarily i.e., forcibly.” Now everyone knows how someone feels when he does something involuntarily. Thus the teaching that accompanies that doctrine seems to be: everything that you do you do involuntarily therefore reluctantly, “against your will” — and this one does not admit because one does many things gladly, even specifically many “moral things.” Thus one understands “unfree will” as “compelled by a foreign will”: as if the claim were: “everything that you do you do compelled by a foreign will.” Your obedience to your own will is not called compulsion: for there is pleasure in it. That you command yourself, that is called: “freedom of will” 1[45] Sapientia victrix? Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future.’ 1[46] Religions live for the longest time without being mixed with morality: morality-free. Consider what any religion really wants — it is still palpable even today: what one wants from it is not redemption from distress, but above all redemption from the fear of distress. All distress is considered to be the consequence of the evil, hostile reigning of spirits: all distress that afflicts

someone is of course not “deserved,” but it raises the thought through which a spirit might be irritated at us; the human being trembles before unknown roaming ungracious monsters and wishes to render them gracious. In so doing he examines his behavior: [Page 279] 272 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS and if there are any means at all to render friendly certain spirits that he knows, then he will ask himself whether he has really done everything that he could have done in this regard. As a courtier examines his own behavior toward the ruler when he has perceived an ungracious mood in him: — he looks for some omission etc. “Sin” is originally that whereby some spirit could be sorely offended, some omission, a — — — : there one must again make something good. — Only insofar as a spirit, a divinity also expressly sets forth certain moral commandments as means to please and serve him, does the moral valuation enter into “sin” as well: or rather: only then can an offense against a moral commandment be perceived as “sin,” as something that separates from God, insults him and also has dangers and distress from him in its wake. 1[47] Cleverness, caution and provision (in contrast to indolence and to living in the moment) — now one nearly means to debase an action if one names these motives. But what has it cost to cultivate these traits! To regard cleverness as virtue — is still Greek! Likewise then sobriety and “presence of mind” in contrast to acting from violent impulses, to “naïveté” of acting. 1[48] Absolute devotion (in religion) as reflex of slavish devotion or of the feminine (— the eternal-feminine*! is idealized slave sense) 1[49] Measuring the moral value of an action according to its intent: presupposes that the intent really is the cause of the action — which actually means regarding the intent as a perfect knowledge as “thing in itself.” In the end it is only the consciousness a(nd) the interpretation of a state (of malaise, desire etc.) [Page 28] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 21 moral faculty. Here lay the magic of his philosophy: the young theologians of the Tübingen Seminary’c went into the bushes — they all searched for “faculties.” And what didn’t they find! Schelling christened it “intellectual intuition,” a faculty for the “supersensual.” Schopenhauer believed he had found the same thing and more, namely “the thing in itself” in an already sufficiently respected faculty, in the will. In England there arose the instinctivists and intuitionists of morality. It was the old subject of faith and knowledge, a kind of “formal faith” that laid claim to some content. This story essentially concerns the theologians. In secret Leibniz comes alive again, and behind Leibniz — Plato. Concepts as G&vapyoung” etc. This initially skeptical movement is indeed directed against skepticism, it takes pleasure in subservience 3483] NB. The most annoying quality of the writings of obscure, poorly trained and unphilological spirits is not even their inadequate capacity for inference and the unsteady, wobbly gait of their logic. It is the unsteadiness of the concepts themselves, for which they make use of words: these people have only shapeless floating splotches of concepts in

their heads. — But the good author is distinguished not only by the strength and concision of his sentence structure: but one notices, one smells, if one is a man of subtle nostrils, that such a writer constantly compels himself and practices first to establish his concepts in a rigorous manner and make them firmer, thus to connect unequivocal concepts with his words: and, until this is done, he will not write! — Moreover there is some charm also in the uncertain, twilight, half-light: this perhaps was Hegel's effect on foreigners mostly through his art of speaking like a drunkard of the most sober and cold things. In the great realm of intoxications this was really one of the rarest ever invented — and quite uniquely a matter of German ingenuity! For wherever Germans and German "virtues" have penetrated, we have also brought along and transported the lust and desire for crude and refined [Page 280] I AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 273 [50] — states and desires are supposed to be described with language: therefore concepts are signs for recognizing. The aim at logic is not in it: logical thinking is a dissolution. But each thing that we "comprehend," each state is a synthesis that one does not "comprehend," but can indeed describe: and even this only insofar as one recognizes a certain similarity to what has been. "Unscientific" indeed is every inner spiritual action, also every thinking. [51] Thinkers of humble or dishonest lineage falsely understand the lust to rule, also the drive to distinction: they relegate both to vanity, as if it were a matter of standing there respected, feared or adored in the opinion of other human beings. [52] Measured according to scientific standards, the value of each moral value judgment of humans over humans is very meager: there is a groping and fumbling and much delusion and ignorance in every word. [53] These are separate tasks: 1) to grasp and determine the current (and in a limited cultural sphere) dominating kind of moral assessment of humans and actions 2) the entire morality codex of a period is a symptom e.g., as a means of self-admiration or dissatisfaction or tartuffery: secondly therefore, in addition to determining the current character of morality, the meaning and interpretation of this character still needs to be given. For in itself it is ambiguous. 3) to explain the emergence of this manner of judgment that is dominating right now [Page 281] 274 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 4) to give a critique of it or to ask: how strong is it? what does it affect? what becomes of humankind (or of Europe) under its sway? Which powers does it promote, which does it suppress? Does it make us healthier, sicker, braver, subtler, more art-needy etc.? Here already it is presupposed that there is no eternal morality: this should be accepted as proven. As little as there is an eternal kind of judgment about nourishment. But new is the criticism, the question: is "good" really "good"? And what use perhaps is had by what is now neglected and maligned? Distances in time have to be considered. [54] The character of the absolute will to power is present in the entire realm of life. If we have a right to deny consciousness, then hardly the right to deny the driving affects, e.g., in a

rain forest. (consciousness always contains a double mirroring — there is nothing direct —) [55] Fundamental question: how deep does the ethical go? Does it belong only to what is learned? Is it a form of expression? All profounder human beings are of one mind in this — it enters the consciousness of Luther Augustine Paul — that our morality and its events do not correspond to our conscious will — in sum, that the explanation from purpose-intentions does not suffice. [56]? Remaining objective, hard, firm, strict in asserting an idea — this is still best accomplished by artists; but if people are needed for this (like teachers, politicians etc.) then the calm and coolness and hardness quickly go away. In natures such as Caesar and Napoleon one can intuit something of a “disinter [Page 282] 1] AUTUMN I—SPRING 1886 275 ested” laboring on one’s marble, regardless of any possible sacrifice of human beings. The future of the highest human beings lies on this path: to bear the greatest responsibility and not collapse under it. —Until now inspirational deceptions were almost always needed in order not to lose faith in one’s right and one’s hand. 1[57] Transformations of the will to power, its elaborations, its specializations — to be represented as parallel to morphological development! 1[58] From the standpoint of each of our fundamental drives there is a different perspectival assessment of all events and experiences. Each of these drives feels itself hindered, or promoted, flattered with respect to every other: each has its own law of development (its high and low, its tempo etc.) — and the latter is dying out when the former rises. The human being as a multiplicity of “wills to power”: each with a multiplicity of means of expression and forms. The individual alleged “passions” (e.g., human beings are cruel) are only fictive unities insofar as that which enters into consciousness as homogeneous on the part of the different fundamental drives is synthetically fictionalized to form a “being” or “faculty,” a passion. In the same manner therefore as the “soul” itself is an expression for all phenomena of consciousness: but which we interpret as the cause of all these phenomena (“self-consciousness” is fictive!) [59] Everything material is a kind of motion symptom for an unknown event: everything conscious and felt on the other hand is symptom of unknown — — — . The world that can be known to us from these two sides could have yet many [Page 283] 276 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS other symptoms. No necessary relationship exists between spirit and material, as if they somehow exhausted the forms of depiction and solely represented them. Movements are symptoms, thoughts are likewise symptoms: desires are verifiably behind both, and the fundamental desire is the will to power. — “Spirit in itself” is nothing, just as “movement in itself” is nothing*? 1[60] It is nearly comical that our philosophers demand that philosophy must begin with a critique of the knowledge faculty: is it not very improbable that the organ of knowledge can “critique” itself when one has become suspicious of the previous results of knowledge? The reduction of philosophy to a “will to a theory

of knowledge” is comical. As if certainty could be found in this manner! — 1[61] Everything that enters into consciousness is the last link of a chain, an ending. That one thought would directly be the cause of another thought is only illusory. The actual connected events play (themselves) out beneath our consciousness: the appearing series and sequence of feelings thoughts etc. are symptoms of what actually happens! — Beneath every thought an affect is hidden. Every thought, every feeling, every will is not born from one specific drive, but it is an overall state, an entire surface of the entire consciousness and results from the momentary power-determination of all the drives that constitute us — therefore of the currently ruling drive as well as the one that obeys or resists it. The next thought is a sign of how the overall power-situation has shifted in the meantime. 1[62] “Will” — a false reification.³⁴ [Page 284] | AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 277 1[63] — How Goethe will look at some point later on! how insecure, how drifting! And his “Faust” — what an incidental and temporal, and insufficiently necessary and durable problem! A degeneration of the knowledgeable one, a sick person, nothing more! In no way the tragedy of the knowledgeable one himself! Not even of the “free spirit.” 1[64] love of humanity. Justice. cruelty. reward and punishment. } everything has already had its self-satisfaction. pro and contra reasonableness. order of rank. slavery (devotion) all praising and blaming is perspectival from the standpoint of a will to power. “innate ideas” the soul, the thing — false. Likewise “the spirit” 1[65]*^o Chapter on interpretation reification the afterlife of bygone ideals (e.g., slave sense in Augustine) 1[66] The love of humanity of the Christian, which makes no distinctions, is only possible in the continuous beholding of God, in relation to which the order of rank between human and human is growing disappearingly tiny, and the human itself generally is becoming so insignificant that relative sizes are no longer of interest: as from atop a high mountain big and small become ant-like and similar. — One should not overlook this [Page 285] 278 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS underestimation of the human being generally, which lies in the Christian feeling of love for humanity: “you are my brother, I already know how you feel, no matter who you are — namely bad!” etc. In fact such a Christian is an extremely obtrusive and immodest sort. Conversely: if we let God go, then we are lacking a type of being that is higher than the human: and our eye becomes refined for the differences of this “highest being.” 1[67] — I am mistrustful of the contemplative, self-contained,^{o*o} fortunate among the philosophers — what is lacking there is the shaping force and the subtlety in honesty that admits to itself lack as a force 1[68] The transformation of morally depraved into morally revered — and vice versa. 1[69] — some select an absolute obligation from within and at times make one up, others want to prove it and thus plant with it at the same time — 1[70]*^o — how immodest humans appear with their religions, even if they are groveling before God, like the saintly

Augustine! What obtrusiveness! This fatherly or grandfatherly principle in the background! 1[71] — Among mortals so far morality has been regarded as the most serious thing there is: this has been good for the moralists, for whom among gods — and perhaps also among human beings — no small laughter is waiting: in the long run one never [Page 286] 1] AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 279 bears the dignity of an instructor unpunished. To “instruct” humans, to “improve” humans — the presumption of such an undertaking 1[72] That the cat human being always lands on its four feet, I meant to say on its single leg “ego,” is only a symptom of its psychological “unity,” better “union”: no reason to believe in a “psychic unity.” [73] — Morality is a part of the theory of affects: how far do the affects reach into the heart of existence? 1[74] If there were an “in itself” at all, what then would be the “In itself” of a thought? 1[75] Thoughts are the signs of a game and struggle of affects: they are always connected to their hidden roots 1[76] Whoever measures the value of an action according to the intention from which it occurs, does so meaning the conscious intention: but in all actions there is much unconscious intentionality; and what appears in the foreground as “will” and “purpose” is manifoldly explicable and in itself only a symptom. “A pronounced, pronounceable intention” is an explication, an interpretation that can be false; moreover an arbitrary simplification and falsification etc [77] The calculation of pleasure as a possible consequence of an action and the pleasure associated with an action itself, as the [Page 287] 280 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS triggering of a pent-up and stored-up force: what sort of effort has it already cost to keep these two pleasures separated! It is laughable! Just as the amenity of life — and d/iss are confused for moral drunkenness and self-adoration. 1[78] With human knowledge morality too has refined itself a) instead of sin as a transgression against God “injustice toward myself” b) instead of praying and the longing for wondrous help — c) instead of the interpretation of experience as reward and punishment — d) instead of hostility toward every kind of plight and unrest and strife — e) instead of the obtrusive equalizing love of humanity of the Christian — 1[79] The greatest sincerity and conviction about the value of one’s own work achieves nothing: likewise my doubting underestimation cannot touch its value. This is how it is with all actions: however moral I may seem to myself with an intention, in itself here (nothing) is decided about the value of the intention and even less about the value of the action. The entire descent of an action would have to be known, and not only the little piece of it that falls into consciousness (the so-called intention) But this would be like demanding absolute knowledge — 1[80] To what extent an overcoming of the moral human being is possible: we no longer measure the value of an action by its consequences we also no longer measure it by its intention [Page 288] 1 AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 281 1[81] As little as we still pray and raise up our hands will we someday need slander and

defamation in order to treat certain drives in us as enemies; and likewise our power, that forces us to destroy humans and institutions, can do this someday without our personally having to succumb to emotions of outrage and disgust: to destroy with a divine eye and unperturbedly! Beginning with the annihilation of human beings who feel themselves to be good! experimentum crucis?' 1[82]*? Beyond Good and Evil Attempt at an Overcoming of Morality. By Friedrich Nietzsche. 1[83] The religious interpretation overcome. Morality belongs in the theory of affects (only a means for their taming, whereas others should be cultivated. 1[84]* The Overcoming of Morality. So far the human being has preserved itself meagerly, in that it has maliciously treated and slandered the drives that are most dangerous to it and likewise in a servile manner has flattered those that preserve it. The gaining of new powers and lands a) the will to untruth b) the will to cruelty c) the will to lust d) the will to power [Page 289] 282 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 1[85] aimed at the understanding of the external world and communicating to it, the intellect and senses must be superficial. Complete emptiness of logic — 1[86] "Division of labor, memory, exercise, habit, instinct, heredity, faculty, force" — all words with which we explain nothing, but certainly describe and indicate. 1[87]*! The "ego" (which is not one with the unified governing of our nature!) is after all only a conceptual synthesis — therefore there is absolutely no acting from "egoism" 1[88] — that some conscious or unconscious calculation of pleasure that one has as a result of acting (whether in the action or later), is really the cause of the action, is a hypothesis!!! 1[89] We belong to the character of the world, there is no doubt! We have no access to it other than through us: everything that is lofty and lowly in us must be understood as necessarily belonging to its nature! 1[90] NB. We want to honestly admit to ourselves our inclinations and disinclinations and resist decorating them from moral paint pots. Thus certainly we will no longer interpret our plight as our "struggle with God and the devil"! Let us be naturalistic and concede a good right even to that which we must fight, in ourselves and outside ourselves! [9x] Through the division of labor the senses are nearly detached from thinking and judging: whereas earlier this lay in them, [Page 29] 22 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS types of alcohol. — Perhaps even the captivating power of our German music belongs here. 34[84] NB. What Plato and at bottom all post-Socratics did: that was a certain legislation of concepts: — they firmly established for themselves and their disciples "this and that should be thought and sensed with this word": — therewith they freed themselves most definitively from their time and environment. This is one of the kinds of subtle disgust with which superior, more demanding natures rise up against the obscure crowd and their conceptual chaos: 34[85] What is this tremendous power that for 2 thousand years has made fools of philosophers and toppled the reason of the reasonable? That instinct, that belief as it is demanded by Christianity: this is the

herd instinct itself, the herd belief of the animal “human,” the herd longing for complete subservience to an authority — (the same thing that Kant christened the “categorical imperative” out of German herd instinct.) In fact it is the greatest relief and boon to endangered vacillating tender weak herd animals to get someone who commands absolutely, a bellwether: it is their first condition of life.⁹⁸ The Brahmins knew this relief well, likewise the Jesuits, in nearly all monasteries the basic tendency is this: to finally rid oneself of the eternal agitation that commanding oneself brings with it. This instinct for faith is also the genuine feminine instinct; and when women find one implacable teacher who wants obedience and subservience from them, or even only one artist who shows woman in the attitude of her “perfection,” as an adoring worshipping devoted creature, as victim, like e.g., R{ichard) Wagner), then they are “beside themselves” for joy: namely sated and satisfied before herself in her ultimate instinct. — In a weaker form one sees this in the French, who as the most [Page 290] I] AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 283 undifferentiated. Still earlier the desires and the senses must have been one. 1[92] All struggle — all events are a struggle — needs duration. What we call “cause” and “effect” leaves out the struggle and consequently does not correspond to the events. It is consistent to deny time in causes a(nd) effects.⁹⁹ 4 1[93]° *Let us free ourselves from a bit of the superstition that so far has been routine with respect to philosophers.* 1[94] *The New Enlightenment. Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future.* By Friedrich Nietzsche. x[95]° Free Spirits and Other Philosophers. Beyond Good and Evil. r[96]*° Moralism Morality. 1197] On the confusion of cause and symptom Desire and aversion are the oldest symptoms of all value judgments: but not causes of value judgments! Therefore: desire and aversion belong like the moral and aesthetic judgments under one category. 1[98] Words remain: people believe, even the concepts referred to by them! [Page 291] 284 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 1[99] We are lacking many concepts for expressing relationships: how quickly we are ready with “master and servant” “father and child” etc.! 1[100] Basic misunderstanding: one person interprets every other according to himself; therefore misunderstanding of many virtues and affects that correspond to a higher kind. Even the same person understands himself falsely when in lower moments he looks back on his high festive times. “Selfdebasement” “humility” rhor] Oh, do you know the mute tenderness with which the evil and terrible human being dwells on that moment when he once — or still — was “different”! No one sees virtue so seductively, so much woman and child. 1[102] In the purest spring a single drop of dirt is enough — 1[103] The hand that wanted to reach out for a prayer, the mouth prepared to sigh — here the free spirit has his overcoming, but also his damming up. One day the dam will be overrun by wild waters — 1[104] Many of the more refined want calm, peace from their affects — they strive for objectivity, neutrality, they are satisfied to be

left over as spectators — and as critical spectators with a curious and bold superiority. Others want calm on the outside, undangerousness of life — they would like not to be envied and not attacked — and prefer to give “everyone his right” — call it “righteousness” and love of humanity etc. For the chapter: “Virtues as Disguise.” [Page 292] | AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 285 1[105] The loss in all specializations: the synthetic nature is the higher. Now all organic life is already a specialization; the inorganic world that stands behind it is the greatest synthesis of forces and therefore the highest and most venerable. — Error, perspectival limitation are lacking there. 1[106] Artists: inspired, sensual, childish, now overly suspicious, now overly trusting 1[107] — Are you someone who as thinker is loyal to his proposition, not like a pettifogger, but like a soldier to his orders? There is disloyalty not only against persons. 1[108] — Compassion in someone who has happiness and courage enough to be able even to stand aside and /ook aside, like an Epicurean god. 1[109]” *The Mirror. Philosophy of Forbidden Knowledge. By Friedrich Nietzsche.* 1[110]® God has been refuted, not the devil. For clear-sighted and suspicious eyes that know how to gaze deeply enough into the backgrounds the spectacle of events is proof neither of truthfulness nor fatherly concern or superior reasonableness; neither something noble nor something pure and trustworthy. [Page 293] 286 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 1111] Northern unnaturalness. everything coated with silvery mists, one can only arrive at feeling good artificially,” art there is a kind of avoidance of oneself. Oh, this pale pleasure, this October light on all pleasures! Northern artificiality 1[112] The Tempter. By Friedrich Nietzsche. 1[113] Harmlessness of our critical philosophers, who do not notice that skepticism — — — : they believe, if one first tests the tool before applying it, namely the capacity for knowledge — — — . This is even worse than wanting to test a match before one wants to use it. It is the match that wants to test itself to see if it burns 1[114] The absolute necessity of all events contains nothing of a compulsion: whoever has thoroughly acknowledged and empathized this stands high in knowledge. From his belief no forgiving and pardoning results — I cross out a sentence that does not turn out well, just as I acknowledge the necessity by virtue of which I failed at it, for the noise of a wagon disturbed me — thus we cross out actions, and in some cases human beings, because they did not turn out well. “To comprehend everything”? — that would mean suspending all perspectival relations, that would mean comprehending nothing, misjudging the nature of knowing. [Page 294] | AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 287 1[115]}>! The interpretive character of all events. There is no event in itself. What happens is a group of appearances selected and summarized by an interpreting being. 1116] Fear has been further developed into the sense of honor, envy into fairness (“to each his own” and even “equal rights”) obtrusiveness of the isolated and endangered into loyalty — — — 1[117] the melancholy of the spirit that stays in

place wherever it happens to end up, the indolence that does not want to learn anew, the good-natured subservience to a power and joy in serving, the moist-warm brooding over thoughts, desires — all German — origin of loyalty and faith. 1[118]°2 The splitting of a protoplasm in 2 occurs when its power no longer suffices to control the appropriated possession: reproduction is the result of an impotence.” Where the males search for females out of hunger and are absorbed by them, reproduction is the result of a hunger.>4 1[119] The absolutely identical process, but the higher interpretation of the process!! The mechanistic sameness” of force, but the increase of the feeling of power! “The second time” —but there is no “second time.” The absolute lack of effect of the inner feeling of power as causality — — — 1[120]°° The same text allows innumerable interpretations: there is no “correct” interpretation. [Page 295] 288 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 1[21]°” Gai saber. Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future. 1. Free Spirits and other Philosophers. 2. World-Interpretation, not World-Explanation. 3. Beyond Good and Evil. 4. The Mirror. An Opportunity for Self-Mirroring for Europeans. 5. The Philosophy of the Future. 1[122]>8 Overcoming of Affects? No, if it is supposed to mean their weakening and annihilation. Rather taking them into service: to which may belong tyrannizing them for a long time (not only as individuals, but as community, race etc.) Finally one restores to them ever more confidently their freedom: they love us like good servants and go willingly wherever our best wants to go. 1[123]°? Happiness and self-contentedness of the Lazzaroni® or “bliss” in “beautiful souls” a(nd) consumptive bodies a(nd) Herrnhuter Pietists®! prove nothing with respect to the order of rank of human beings. As a greater educator, one would have to mercilessly flog a race of such “blessed humans” into misfortune: the danger of diminution, of relaxation is immediately there: against Spinozistic or Epicurean happiness and against all relaxation in contemplative states. But if virtue is the means to such happiness, well, then one must also become master over virtue 1[124] How do the perspective sphere and error emerge? Insofar as, by virtue of an organic being, not a being as such, but instead struggle itself wants to preserve itself, wants to grow and wants to be conscious of itself. [Page 296] I AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 289 That which we call “consciousness” and “spirit” is only a means and tool by virtue (of which) not a subject, but 4 struggle wants to preserve itself. The human being is proof of what enormous forces can be set in motion by a small being of manifold content (or by a perennial struggle concentrated on many small beings) Beings that play with stars 1[125]°2 — To transform the belief “it is thus and such” into the will “thus and (such) it shall be.” 1[126]° — The Paths to the Saint. Conclusion of “The Will to Power.” 1[127]°4 — there must be those who sanctify all their actions, not only eating and drinking: and not only in memory of them, or in becoming one with them, but always anew and in a new manner this world should be

transfigured. 1[128] — what is essential about an organic being is a new interpretation of events, the perspectival inner multiplicity, which itself is an event. 1[129]® — the saints as the strongest humans (through self-overcoming, freedom, loyalty etc. 1[130]®° — to deny merit, but to do that which is above all praise, indeed above all understanding [Page 297] 290 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS [131] The Will to Power. 1[132] — a great human being who feels a right to sacrifice humans as a general sacrifices humans; not in the service of an “idea” but because he wants to rule. 1[133] — less and less physical strength is necessary: with cleverness one lets machines work, the human being becomes more powerful and more spiritual. [134] — why it is necessary today occasionally to speak crudely and act crudely. Something subtle and kept secret is no longer understood, not even by those who are related to us. That of which one does not speak loudly or shout, that does not exist: pain, privation, task, the long duty and the great overcoming — No one sees and smells anything of this. Cheerfulness is construed as a sign of lack of profundity: that it can be the bliss after all too severe tension, who knows that? — One goes around with actors and tries very hard to respect even there. But no one understands to what extent it is hard and painful for me to go around with actors. Or with a phlegmatic sensualist who has enough spirit to — 1[135] — I have charged the Germans with philistinism and being comfortable: but this /etting-oneself-go is European and “contemporary,” not only in morality and art. 1136] — not to allow oneself that a virtue is made of curiosity and of the zeal of research, a “will to truth.” The scholars of Port [Page 298] I AUTUMN 1885-SPRING 1886 291 Royal knew this and took this more rigorously. But we have allowed all our inclinations to go to seed and afterwards we also want to have the beautiful name of virtues for them. But virtue belongs to the productions of stronger and more evil ages: it is a privilege of aristocrats. 1[137] I wonder about the most acknowledged things of morality —and other philosophers, like Schopenhauer, have only paused before the “wonders” in morality. 1[138]68 Discords and dialogues 1[139] Artists begin to value and overvalue their works when they cease to have respect for themselves. Their raging demand for fame often veils a sad secret. The work does not belong to their rule, they feel it as their exception. — Perhaps they also want that their works intercede for them as advocacy, perhaps that others deceive them about themselves. Finally: perhaps they want noise in themselves, in order no longer to “hear” themselves. 1[140] “God wants my best when he visited sorrow upon me” — It is your responsibility to interpret this to your best: it meant no more even for religious people. 1[141] Beyond Yes and No. Questions and Question Marks for Questionable Ones. [Page 299] 292 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 1[142] We know better than we admit to ourselves that W(agner) is poor, that a thought rarely comes to him, that he himself is most startled, delighted, bowled over by his appearance and for an overly long time has not

tired of stroking and decorating these wonders of thought. He is too grateful and does not know the cold affability of the rich, even less their tender disgust, the weariness of those who do nothing but bestow — like Mozart, like Rossini: only the superabundant fountains leap and dance. 1[143]® “We Lizards of Happiness? Thoughts of a Grateful One.”? 1[144]” The Last Virtue. A Morality for Moralists [145]? — this last virtue, our virtue is called: honesty. In all other respects we are only the heirs and perhaps the squanderers of virtues that are not gathered and hoarded by us 1[146] A moralist: by which I mean etc. Question and objection: has there ever been a m(oralist)? — Perhaps no, perhaps yes; in any case from now on there should be only such m(oralists). 1[147] Let us flee, my friends, from what is boring, from the overcast sky, from the waddle-geese, from the honorable woman, from the spinsters who write and “lay” books — is life not too short to bore ourselves? [Page 3] Contents A NOTE ON THIS EDITION Ix

Unpublished Fragments (Spring 1885—Spring 1886) Notebook 34 = N VII 1
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 1a. Mp XVI 2a. Mp XV 2b. June-July 1885 Notebook 39 = N VII 2a. Z I 2b.
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 30] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 23 good-natured Europeans are also the most
 herdlike: they only feel good when they are allowed by their esprit? “to obey
 unconditionally” for once: as in the presence of Napoleon. Or also in the
 presence of “the ideas of the French Revolution” — or also in the presence of
 Victor Hugo (who throughout his whole long life always adorned this most
 beautiful of all herd instincts with beautiful words and coats of pomp in the name
 of freedom). — When Christianity came along antiquity was inwardly torn back
 and forth by opposites of valuations (as a result of the physiological conditioning
 of the nonsensical equality concept *civis romanus* or by that nonsensical state
 expansion of the *imperium romanum*®) and Christianity provided the great
 relief. 34[86] Words are acoustical signs for concepts: but concepts are more or
 less definite groups of recurring sensations that arrive together. In order to
 understand one another it does not yet suffice that people use the same words:
 one must also use the same words for the same species of inner experience —
 and this one must have in common. This is why representatives of a single
 people understand each other better: or, when human beings have lived together
 for a long time under similar conditions of climate, activities, needs, then a
 certain variety of experiences that are most closely understood by them all gains
 the upper hand: the result is a quick comprehension of one another. And marriage
 and inheritance are again the result of it. It is the need to convey one’s needs

quickly and easily that binds human beings most firmly to one another. On the other hand nothing holds a friendship, a love affair together when it is discovered that one means something different with words. Which groups of sensations are in the foreground is determined by valuations: but valuations are the result of our innermost needs. — This is said to explain why it is difficult to understand writings like mine: the inner experiences, valuations and needs are [Page 300]] AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 293 1[148] “The World as Will and Representation” — translated back into the narrow and personal, into Schopenhauerian: “The world as sex-drive and contemplativeness.” 1[149] The German empire is distant to me, and there is no reason for me to be friend or foe with respect to a thing that lies so distant to me. 1[150] So far we have been so well behaved toward women. Woe, the time will come when in order to interact with a woman one must first always hit her in the mouth. 1[r]7? The Paths to the Saint. What are Strong Spirits? On Herd-Animal Morality 1[152] New Dangers and New Securities A Book for Strong Spirits. x(153)”4 NB. Against Aryan and Semitic. Where races are mixed, the source of great culture. [154] What is Noble? Thoughts on Order of Rank. 1[155] What are we waiting for anyway? Is it not for a great herald and trumpet-noise! What happiness lies in loud sounds! There [Page 301] 294 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS is a silence that suffocates: we have been hearkening”® too long already. 1[156] Whoever has the greatest gifts to give, searches for those who understand how to take — he searches perhaps in vain? In the end he throws away his gift? That kind of thing belongs to the secret history and despair of the richest souls: it is perhaps the most misunderstood and melancholy of all misfortunes on earth. [157] That moral judgment, insofar as it represents itself in concepts, looks narrow, clumsy, wretched, almost ridiculous measured against the subtlety of the same judgment insofar as it represents itself in actions, in selecting, rejecting, shuddering, loving, hesitating, doubting, in every touch of human to human. 1[158] how the hearty mediocrity in Germany today feels good, namely feels related with the music of their Brahms — : how the fine and insecure greyhounds of the Parisian spirit today sniff around their Renan with a lusty flattery — i[159] The value of monarchs on the rise! 1[160]’7 How treacherous are all parties! — they bring to light something about their leaders that perhaps has been hidden by them under a bushel with great skill 1[161] Perhaps everyone has his standard for what is regarded as “superficial” by him: well then, I have my own — a crude, simplistic standard for my use at home, as it fits my hand — may others have a right to more ticklish, fine-tongued instruments! [Page 302] I AUTUMN I—SPRING 1886 295 Whoever feels suffering to be an argument against life, I regard to be superficial, along with our pessimists; likewise whoever sees a goal in well-being. 1[162]78 The orgiastic soul. — I have seen him: his eyes at least — they are by turns deep still, then green and slippery honey-eyes his halcyonic smiling

the sky looked on bloody and cruelly the orgiastic soul of woman I have seen him: his halcyonic smiling, his honey-eyes, in turn deep and veiled, then green, slippery, a trembling surface, slippery, sleepy, trembling, tarrying, the sea wells up in his eyes 1[163]”° 1. Caesar among pirates 2. On the bridge. 3. The wedding. — and suddenly, while the sky falls darkly 4. Ariadne. 1[164] This music — Dionysian after all? dance? cheerfulness? the tempter? the religious flood? beneath Plato’s pillow Ar(istophanes)? 1[165]®° our street musicians and h(umans) of a dishonest burial — they are the closest kin of witches, they have their Blocksbergs*®! 1[166] the mystical nature, soiled by vices and foaming [Page 303] 296 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 1[167]8? the goodly and pure spring that is never again able to get over a drop of garbage that fell into it, until in the end it is yellow and poisoned through and through: — the corrupted angels 1[168] “We Immoralists.” 1169] “Hail to thee, if you know what you do; but if you do not know it, then you are under the law and under the law’s curse” Jesus of Nazareth. 1[170] Industriousness, as a mark of an ignoble kind of human (which, as is self-evident, therefore is still an estimable and indispensable kind of human — explanatory note for asses!) in our age would like — — — [171] compared to Rabelais and that exuberant power of the senses whose characteristic he is, — — — 1[172] Raphael without hands *the monasteries and hermitages of culture this music is not sincere* “As little state as possible”® — the anti-national powers For someone for whom “objectivity” “contemplativeness” is already the highest state, like Schopenhauer — he does not know enough the fortune of finding® an unbroken naive egoism the tartuffery of the Germans! the old woman represented as the emanation of their sense of duty — I heard it with my own ears. [Page 304] I AUTUMN 1885-SPRING 1886 297 The screaming and scribbling of ugly girls — the decreasing influence of woman. the new Melusine® As much militaristics as possible, the kings who are fired upon — the sacrificing of the bivouac, without door and window the loaded revolver “the cause of every action an act of consciousness,” a knowing! Consequently the bad actions only errors etc. The famous words “forgive them?” their” the universalization “tout comprendre”®® — superficial words “the great ambiguous one and tempter” 1173] a cold reluctant lake, on which no delight ripples 1174” not yet one hour among my kind, with everything I do and try the secret worm “you have other things to do!” tortured by children geese and dwarves, nightmare — only such types are around him, against whom he can neither retaliate nor give instruction — — — 1[175] pampered consciences 1[176] the little sorrow 1177] Of a great human being. His descendants say of him: “since then things climbed higher and higher.” — But they understand nothing of this ordeal of climbing; a great human being is pushed, pressed, crowded, tortured-up into Ais height. [Page 305] 298 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 1[178]°° This is a problem of race as I

understand it: for as concerns that clumsy drivell about Aryan — — — [179] The Jesuitism of mediocrity that seeks to break or weaken the extraordinary and tense human being like a bow that is dangerous to it, with compassion and comfortable out-stretched hands as well as with poisoning of his necessary solitude and with secretive pollution of his faith — : which has its triumph when it can say “that one has finally become like one of us”: this domineering Jesuitism that is the driving force in the entire democratic movement will, everywhere, quite removed from politics and the questions of nourishment a(nd) — — — 1[180] Mozart the flower of the German baroque — 1[181] Inspiration. — 1[182] It is difficult to be understood. He should have heartfelt gratitude for even the good will to a bit of subtlety of interpretation: on good days one demands nothing more at all. One should concede to one’s friends an abundant space”! for misunderstandings. It seems to me better to be misunderstood than not understood: there is something insulting in being understood. To be understood? You really know what that means? — Comprendre c’est égal.* It flatters more to be misunderstood than not understood: one remains cold toward the incomprehensible, and coldness offends. [Page 306] I AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 299 1[183] Alas, this is the sea: and this bird is supposed to build its nest here? On those days when the sea becomes still and — — — 1[184] On the greed of the spirit: where, as with avarice, the means become the end. Insatiability. Today one loves everything that is fatalistically tremendous: so too the spirit. 1[185]”? The Discipline of the Spirit. Thoughts on the Intellectual Conscience. The avarice and insatiability of the spirit: — its tremendous, fatalistic, nocturnally roaming, pitiless, predatory and cunning qualities. 1[186]?4 The Scholar. What is Truth? On the Spirit's Lack of Discipline. The Demagogic in our Arts. Master and Slave Morality. Morality and Physiology. Piety. On the History of the Free Spirit. We Immoralists. The Noble Soul. The Mask. [Page 307] 300 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 1[187]” L What is Truth? 2. On the Natural History of the Scholar. 3. The Mask 4. On the Noble Soul. 5. We Immoralists. 6. Herd Morality. 7. On the Demagoguery of the Arts. 8. Piety. 9. The Good Europeans. 10. The Philosophers of the Future. Skeptics. Free Spirits. Strong Spirits. Tempter. Dionysus. 1[188]?° First Part: our courage Second part: our compassion Third Part: our insight Fourth part: our solitude [189] 1. Morality and Knowledge. 2. Morality and Religion 3. Morality and Art. 4. “We Europeans.” 5. What is Noble? Inspiration [Page 308] 1 AUTUMN I—SPRING 1886 301 1[190] Among those who have freed themselves of religion I find human beings of many kinds and ranks. There are the intemperate, who have allowed themselves to be persuaded by their senses (because their senses no longer tolerated the compulsion and accusation of the religious ideal) — and who like to avail themselves of reason a(nd) of taste as their advocates, as if they could no longer tolerate the unreasonable, the distasteful aspects of religion: — what suits this kind of human being is

antireligious hatred, malice and sardonic laughter, but likewise in well-concealed moments a yearning shame, an inner subservience to the valuations of the renounced ideal. Alienated from the Church by sensuality, when they return to it they venerate the ideal of desensualization, as the religious “ideal in itself”: — a source of many and difficult errors. There are the more spiritual, less feeling, drier, also more conscientious human beings who from the ground up are incapable of believing in an ideal at all, and who know how to find their greatest strength and self-respect only in subtle nay-saying and critical disintegrating: they are freed because there is nothing in them that could have firmly bound; they free because — — — phases — loss, desolation, including in the feeling of disloyalty a(nd) ingratitude, breaking free, all outweighed by an irrefutable bitter certainty the feeling of respectful consideration and a shy earnestness (with great kindness toward the A(omines) religiosi’) the feeling of superior a(nd) kindly cheerfulness toward all religions mixed with a slight disdain for the impurity of the intellectual conscience, which still allows many to be religious, or a scarcely concealed amazement that it is possible to “believe” 1191] NB. Ultimately the whole of a Greek city was indeed more valuable than an individual! it is still preserved for us! — as [Page 309] 302 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS certainly as the body is more valuable than some organ. Learning to obey, 1000 times in the body the highest sacrifice! 1[192] more cleanly washed and more cleanly clothed skillful gymnasts with a lock on their “loose snouts,” training themselves for silence, also for a dignified self-control in Venere” (and not, as so often, debauched and botched from boyhood on): may we soon see them “Europeanized” in this direction 1[193] I love the magnificent frolicsomeness of a young predator that gracefully plays, and in playing tears to pieces r[194]!0° Modern pessimism is an expression of the uselessness of the modern world — not of the world and of existence. 1[195] It seems more and more to me that we are not superficial and not good-natured enough to help with this Junker fatherland-mania of the Brandenburg March!” and to sing along with its hatred-snorthing stupefaction-slogan “Deutschland Deutschland über Alles.”!° 1[196]!3 — one has to sink down to the old Wagner and his Bayreuther Blatter to encounter a similar swamp of presumption, obscurity and Teutomania as are the Addresses to the G(erman) N«ation).’4 1197] The old Romantics fall down and one day, one knows not how, they are stretched out on the ground before the cross: that also happened to Richard Wagner. To be one of those witnessing the degeneration of such a human being belongs to [Page 31] 24 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS different in me. For years I have interacted with people and taken my resignation and courtesy so far as to never speak of things that were in my heart. Indeed I have lived with people almost exclusively so. — 34[87] We imagine to ourselves that the commanding, supreme thing lies in our consciousness. Ultimately we have a double brain: our capacity to will, to feel

and to think something of our willing, feeling, thinking ourselves is what we summarize with the word “consciousness.” 34[88] NB. Those law-giving and tyrannical spirits who are in a position to firmly establish a concept, firmly maintain it, people with this spiritual strength of will who know how to ossify for a long time and nearly eternalize the most fluid of things, the spirit, are commanding human beings in the highest sense: they say “I want to know this and that was seen, I want it precisely thus, I want it for this and only for this.” This kind of law-giving human being necessarily exerted the strongest influence in all ages: we have them to thank for all typical elaborations of the human being: they are the sculptors — and the rest (“most” people) in this case —) compared to them are only clay. 34[89] The most firmly established movements of our intellect, our law-like gymnastics e.g., in representations of space and time, or in the need for “justification”: this philosophical habitus of the human intellect is our actual potency: therefore such that in many intellectual things we can no longer do otherwise: which is called psychological necessity. This has become: and to believe our space, our time, our causality instinct is something that has meaning even apart from mankind is well-nigh a childishness. [Page 310] 1 AUTUMN I—SPRING 1886 303 the most painful things I have experienced: — that one did not perceive it as painful in G(ermany) was a strong impulse for me to mistrust even more that spirit that now rules in G(ermany). 1[198]!05 Buatschleli batscheli bim bim bim Buatscheli batscheli bim!!06 1[199] To seize happiness and strangle, suffocate, choke it with one’s embrace: — the melancholy of such experiences — otherwise it would flee and slip away? 1[200] How much someone withstands of truth: How much someone takes upon himself to answer for: How much someone takes upon himself to provide and to protect: Simplicity — and what the colorful taste of artists reveals: 1[20] Middle Class Morality. 1[202] There is something ineducable at bottom: a granite of factum,}’ of predetermined decision in measure and proportion to us and likewise a right to certain problems, a branded stamping of them on our names. The attempt to conform, the agony of solitude, the longing for a community: this can express itself in a thinker in such a way that he subtracts precisely the most personal and valuable from his individual case and, by generalizing, also coarsens.^{oo} In this manner it is possible that the entire articulated philosophy [Page 311] 304 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS of a remarkable human being is not really his philosophy, but precisely that of his environment, from which he deviates as a human being, paratypically. The extent to which modesty, a lack of courageous “I am” becomes fateful in a thinker. “The type is more interesting than the individual and exceptional case”: in this way the scientism of taste can bring someone not to have the requisite sympathy and caution for himself. And finally: style, literature, the toss and fall of words — how all this falsifies and ruins what is personal! Mistrust of writing, tyranny of the vanity of writing well:

which is formal dress anyway and also conceals us. Taste is inimical to the original! an old story. e that communicates: and style that is only a sign, “in Style that t d style that ly a sig memoriam.” Dead style a masquerade; in others lively style. Depersonalization. 1[203] Against an enemy there is no better antidote than a second enemy: for a single enemy — — — [204]! All too much upon myself, since when? almost from childhood on. My philology was only an eagerly seized-on escape: I cannot deceive myself about it, the Leipzig diaries spoke too plainly. — And no companion! — Careless in trusting? But a hermit always has too much supply of that stored up, likewise of course also of mistrust. 1[205] The deepest misunderstanding of religion, “evil human beings have no religion.” 1[206]!!° Russian music: how is it that — — — [Page 312] I AUTUMN 1885— SPRING 1886 305 1[207] The extreme purity of the atmosphere into which I placed him, and which allows me things — — — 1[208] I have become less capable of resisting phys(ical) pain: and now when days come with the old attacks, then the pain immediately transforms into a psychic torture with which I can compare nothing 1[209] The loftiness and goodness of one’s nature are also given away to one’s work: afterwards drought or mud. — 1[210] How good conscience and well-being free us from deep problems! rlr] Beyond good and evil: that takes effort. I translate as if into a foreign language, I am not always certain of having found the meaning. Everything a bit too crude for my liking. 1[212] On brown, yellow, green purple carpets comes 1[213] We early risers, who for the — — — 1[214] Opposite, there are truths that make one vomit, *materia peccans*,¹ that one wants to be rid of at any cost: one gets rid of them by communicating them 1[215]!9 To look upon the plight of the masses with ironic melancholy: they want something that we are capable of — oh! [Page 313] 306 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 1[216] I have never profaned the holy name of love. 1[217] well-rested forces 1[218] if genuine in his objectivity, in his cheerful totality, he is false and deliberate in his affects, artificial and cunning in grasping the details, even in the senses 1[219] NB How during the decrease of life force one sinks down to contemplativeness and to objectivity: a poet can feel it (Sainte-Beuve! !*) 1[220] The tremendous enjoying of human beings and of society in the age of L(ouis) XIV had the effect that people were bored in nature and felt desolated. Desolate nature was the most painful, the high mountains. The *Précieuses*! wanted to bring spirit, at least *esprit* into love. Symptom of a tremendous enjoyment in the spirit (in the bright, distinguishing one, as in the time of the Persian wars) The most artificial forms (Ronsard, even the Scandinavians) cause the greatest joy in very juicy and forceful sensual natures: it is their self-overcoming. Also the most artificial morality. Our human beings want to be hard, fatalistic, destroyers of illusions — desire of weak and tender human beings who relish!!6 the formless, barbaric, form-destroying (e.g., “endless” melody — *Raffinement*”” of German composers) Pessimism and

brutality as stimuli of our precious ones!!⁸ 1[221] Cataline — a romantic next to Caesar, modo celer modo lentus ingressus! [Page 314] I AUTUMN I—SPRING 1886 307 1[222] Freedom of conscience is only useful and possible during great despotism — a symptom of atomization 1[223]!20 NB The last virtue. We are the squanderers of the virtues that our forefathers gathered and, thanks to them, with respect to their long austerity and thriftiness, it may be a good long time that we (behave) like the rich and exuberant heirs. 1[224] gloomy or frolicsome, a spirit who in everything he imagines took revenge for something that he had done (or for not having done something) — who did not understand happiness without cruelty. 1[225] Here, where the peninsula runs into the sea 1[226]!! Whoever does not enjoy watching oafs dance should not read German books. I just watched a German oaf dance: Eugen Dithring, to the tune of the anarchist motto “ni dieu, ni maître??? 1[227] With most people even today their prudence is still the most genuine thing they have: and only those rare ones who know, who feel how they have grown up in the twilight of an aging culture — — — 1[228] I do not understand what the lay-people see in Richard} Wagner): perhaps he arouses their romantic feelings and all the shudder and tickle of the infinite and of romantic mysticism — we musicians are enchanted and seduced [Page 315] 308 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 1[229]!23 Halcyon speeches. — Caesar among pirates — The hour when the sun is down — To love humanity for the sake of God — For those whose laughter is golden. Grateful for being misunderstood — At the golden grill. We lizards of happiness —! Among children and dwarves. On the bridge. On the old fort. The spa. The greatest event — Always disguised. otium Poverty, sickness — and the noble human being the slow eye “One’s equals” — against intimacy Being able to keep silent Slow to reconcile, slow to anger To take all formality under protection. Women. — Dance, folly, little jewelry boxes the tempter. On bloodlines. The mask. 24 I [23 o] 125 Halcyon Songs. x[231]!26 Ariadne. [Page 316] I AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 309 1[232]!27 The Problem of Order of Rank. Provisional Thoughts and Dashes!²⁸ by Friedrich Nietzsche. 1[233] NB. Harm makes us prudent, says the rabble: — To the extent it makes us prudent, it also makes us bad. But how often harm makes us stupid! 1[234] The extent to which a craft physically and spiritually deforms: likewise scientism in itself, likewise earning money, likewise every art: — the specialist is necessary, but belongs in the class of tools. [235] It is very interesting for once to see humans without reins and limits: nearly all superior humans (like artists) fall back into some kind of subordination, be it Christianity or fatherlandishness. 1[236]!29 If this is not an age of decline and of diminishing vitality with much melancholy, then at least it is one of thoughtless, arbitrary experimentation: — and it is probable that from its superabundance of failed experiments an overall impression of something like decline will arise: and perhaps the thing itself, actual decline. [Page 317] 310

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 1[237]!3° The problem of order of rank. The problem of discipline and cultivation. The discipline of the will. The discipline of obeying. NB. The discipline of commanding. The subtlety of differentiation. Education that excludes specialization. 1[238]!3! The deep necessity of the task that reigns over all individual destinies of every human being, in that a task becomes embodied and “comes into the world” — at the midpoint of life I comprehend what the problem of order of rank required by way of preparations, in order to finally rise up within me: — how I had to experience the most manifold states of happiness and distress in soul and in body, losing nothing, tasting everything and testing it to the bottom, purifying and sifting out everything accidental. 1[239] Every morality that dominated anywhere was always the discipline and cultivation of a specific type of human being, assuming that the outcome would be primarily this type, indeed exclusively: in sum, always assuming a type. Every morality believes that with intention and compulsion one can change (“improve”) much in human beings: — it takes the growing resemblance to the standard type as “improvement” (it has absolutely no other concept of it —). 1[2.40]!22 On naiveté. Reflection can still be a sign of n(aiveté). “Naive egoism.” [Page 318] 1] AUTUMN 1885—SPRING 1886 311 1[241] the well-being of one’s “neighbor” is more worthy of striving for 1) if well-being is worth striving for 2) if the kind of well-being is clearly established, because there are those that contradict and impede themselves as goals, 3) if already a value of persons is firmly established and it is clear that “the neighbor” has higher value than I . — The pleasant enthusiastic sentiments??? of devotion etc. must be mercilessly criticized; in themselves they still contain, by virtue of the drop of pleasantness and enthusiasm in them, no argument for, but only a seduction to it. 1[242] Knowledge of human beings: it depends on what one grasps, feels as “experience”; most need a clumsy particularity of the event and hundredfold repetition, and a few require blows with a club in order to get to the bottom of an experience and notice it 1[243] The barbarization of Christianity by the Germans 1[244] Science as a mean to education. Practiced for itself just another barbarism, a barbarizing skill 1[245]!4 Iti vuttakam”° (Thus spoke (the saint) 1[246] do not cheat do not compromise despise such obscurity as Bismarck and Wagner 1[247] How human beings were sick from God and alienated themselves from the human being. [Page 319] [2 = W 18. Autumn 1885—Autumn 1886] 2i)! There is a noble and dangerous carelessness that provides a deep inference and insight: the carelessness of the superabundant soul that has never bothered with friends but knows only hospitality, only ever exercises and knows how to exercise hospitality — heart and house open to everyone who wants to step inside, be they beggars or cripples or kings. This is genuine affability: whoever has it has a hundred “friends,” but probably no friend. 2b] This magnificent spirit, now self-sufficient and well defended and closed off

against attacks: — you are angered by his fortress and secrecy and yet peek curiously through the golden latticework with which he has fenced off his kingdom? — curious and seduced: for an unknown indistinct fragrance blows upon you maliciously and speaks vaguely of secluded gardens and delights. 2(3)? We are in the midst of the dangerous carnival of nationality-madness, where all finer reason has slunk to the side and the vanity of the scruffest nook-peoples cries out for the rights of special existence and self-glorification — how (can) one today [Page 32] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 25 34[90] I am hostile 1) toward desensualization: it stems from the Jews, from Plato, who was ruined by Egyptians and Pythagoreans (and these by Buddhists) We have the Provencal spirit that remained pagan, I mean “not Germanic,” to thank for the spiritualization of the amor of sexual love: whereas antiquity had brought things only as far as a spiritualization of pederasty. 2) toward all doctrines that focus on an end, a calm, a “Sabbath of all Sabbaths.” Such ways of thinking characterize seething, suffering, often also dying races, e.g., such verses as are in R(ichard) Wagner's) “Nibelungs.” 8 34[91] “Habit”: this means something different in a slavishly minded person than in a noble one. 34[92] What we owe the Christian church 1) a spiritualization of cruelty: the idea of hell, tortures and heretic trials, the auto-da-fés are indeed a major advancement over the magnificent but semi-idiotic slaughter in the Roman arenas. Much spirit, much ulterior motive has gotten into cruelty. — It has invented many pleasures. 2) it has made the European spirit subtle and flexible through its “intolerance.” One sees immediately how in our democratic age, with freedom of the press, thought is getting clumsy. The Germans invented gunpowder — hats off! But they canceled it out: they invented the printing press.⁹⁴ The ancient polis was of a very similar mind. The Roman Empire, on the other hand, allowed great freedom in faith and nonfaith: more than any empire allows today: the result was immediately the greatest possible degeneration of civilization and crudening of the spirit. — How good Leibniz and Abelard, Montaigne, Descartes and Pascal look! It is a pleasure to see the supple daring of such [Page 320] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 313 begrudge the Poles, the noblest variety of the Slavic world, entertaining hopes and — — — they tell me that G(ermany) has the great word to say in this regard. ala] Halcyon Interruptions. For Recovering from “Thus Spoke Zarathustra” Dedicated to his Friends by Friedrich Nietzsche 2[5] The exclusive interest that is lavished today in Germany on questions of power, trade and commerce and — last but not least — on “living well,” the rise of parliamentary nonsense, of newspaper reading and of the literati-like chiming in of everyone about everything, the admiration for a statesman who knows and cares just as much about philosophy as a peasant or a fraternity student and thinks he is making his bold ruthless politics of the moment “more acceptable” to German taste (or conscience —) through an antiquated glossing over with royalism and

Christianity — : all of this has its origin in the uncanny and multiply alluring year 1815. At that time suddenly night descended on the German spirit that up till then had experienced a long cheerful day: the “fatherland,” the border, the soil, the ancestor — all kinds of narrow-mindedness suddenly began to assert their rights. Back then reaction and anxiety, fear of the German spirit awakened in the upper classes, and consequently in the lower classes liberalism and revolutionism and the whole political fever — one understands this “consequently.” Since then — since it began to politicize — Germany lost its spiritual leadership of Europe: and now mediocre Englishmen) succeed in {making} the G(ermans) — — — [Page 321] 314 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 2[6] The last two centuries. — It was not until the 17th and 18th centuries that Germany brought its most authentic art, music, to the peak: one may forgive an occasionally melancholy observer if he is capable of recognizing German music of the nineteenth century as only a gleaming manifold and scholarly form of decline. Likewise in the plastic arts it has shown in the same oft-maligned century a wasteful joy and strength: German baroque style in churches and palaces belongs as the closest relative to our music — a(nd) in the sphere of the visual it builds the same genre of bewitchments and seductions that our music is for a different sense. Between Leibniz and Schopenhauer (born 1788) Germany thought through its entire circle of original thoughts, therefore likewise within those centuries: — and even this philosophy, with its powdered wig and conceptual cobweb, its suppleness, its melancholy, its mysterious infinity and mysticism belongs to our music and is a kind of baroque in the sphere of philosophy. 217] The spirit® that we comprehend — we do not resemble it: we are superior to it! 2[8]” What is still young and stands on weak legs always lets out the loudest cry: for it still falls down too often. For example “patriotism” in today’s Europe, “love of the fatherland,” which is only a child: — one should not take the little crybaby too seriously! 2[9]° To my friends. This book, which knew how to find its readers in a broad expanse of countries and peoples and must know some kind of art through which even coy and obstinate ears can be seduced: [Page 322] 2 AUTUMN I—AUTUMN 1886 315 precisely this book has remained most incomprehensible to my closer friends: — when it appeared, it was to them a shock and a question mark and it laid down a long alienation between them and me. In fact, the state from which it arose had enough of the enigmatic and the contradictory to it: at the time I was simultaneously very happy and very suffering — thanks to a great victory over myself that I had come away with, one of those dangerous victories by which one usually is destroyed. One day — it was in summer 1876 — a sudden contempt and insight came to me: and from then on I went mercilessly beyond all the beautiful wishful things on which my youth had bestowed its heart 2[10]° Nationalities-madness and fatherland-buffoonery are without magic for me: “Deutschland, Deutschland über Alles”! is

painful to my ears, at bottom because I want and wish more from the Germans than — . Their first statesman, in whose mind a solid foundation of royalism and Christianity coexists with a ruthless politics of the moment, who is no more touched by philosophy than a peasant or a fraternity student, piques my ironic curiosity. It even seems useful to me that there are a few Germans who have remained indifferent toward the G(erman) E(mpire): not even as spectators but as those who look away. Where then do they look? There are more important things, compared to which these questions are only foreground questions: e.g., the growing ascendancy of the democratic man and the consequent stultification of Europe and diminution of the European human being. 2[11]!! The Intellectual Conscience. Attempt at a Critique of More Spiritual Human Beings. The philosopher. The free spirit. The artist. The religious human being. The scholar. The noble human being. Dionysus. [Page 323] 316 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 2[12]? Inter pares: a phrase that intoxicates — it includes so much happiness and unhappiness for the one who was alone his whole life; who met no one who belonged to him, though he searched in many ways; who in relations with others always had to be the man of benevolent and cheerful disguise, of the sought-after and often found resemblance, and who knows from all too long experience that ability to grin and bear it that people call “affability” — occasionally to be sure also those dangerous heart-rending outbreaks of all suppressed misfortune, all unsuffocated desires, all pent-up torrents of love grown wild — the sudden madness of that hour when the lonely one embraces someone or other and treats him as a friend and a godsend” and a precious gift, only to push him away with disgust an hour later — henceforth disgusted with himself, as if sullied, as if debased, as if estranged from himself, as if sick from his own company — . 2[13]”° This is my suspicion that returns again and again, my worry that never goes to sleep in me, my question that no one hears or wants to hear, my sphinx, next to which there is not only one abyss: — I believe we are deceiving ourselves today about the things we Europeans love most, and a cruel (or not even cruel, only indifferent and childish) goblin is playing with our heart and its enthusiasm, just as perhaps he has already played with everything else that lived and loved — : I believe that what we are accustomed to honoring in Europe today as “humaneness,” “morality,” “humanity,” “sympathy,” “justice” may indeed have their foreground-value as a weakening and mitigation of certain dangerous and powerful basic drives, but in the long run they are nevertheless nothing more than the diminution of the entire type “human being” — its conclusive mediocritization, if one will permit me a desperate word in a desperate situation; I believe the *commedia umana*® for an » [Page 324] 2 AUTUMN I—AUTUMN 1886 317 Epicurean spectator-god would have to consist in the fact that humans, by virtue of their growing morality, fancy that they elevate themselves in all innocence and vanity above animals to the rank of

“gods” and to extraterrestrial destinies, but in truth they are sinking, that is, through the cultivation of all the virtues on the basis of which a herd thrives, and through suppression of those other and opposite virtues, which provide the origin for a new higher stronger masterful species, they are developing only the herd animal in humans and perhaps thereby determining the animal “human being” — for so far the human being was the as yet “undetermined animal” —; I believe that the great forward-driving and relentless democratic movement of Europe — that which calls itself “progress” — and likewise even its preparation and moral prefiguration, Christianity — at bottom signifies only the tremendous instinctive overall conspiracy of the herd against all that is shepherd, beast of prey, hermit and Caesar, in favor of the preservation and raising up of all the weak, oppressed, underprivileged, mediocre, semi-misfits, as a protracted slave rebellion against every kind of master, secretive at first then increasingly more self-conscious, ultimately against even the concept “master,” as a life and death war against every morality that springs from the womb and consciousness of a higher stronger masterful kind of human being, as mentioned above — such a one that requires slavery in some form and under some name as its foundation and condition; I believe, finally, that every enhancement so far in the type human being was the work of an aristocratic society that believed in a long ladder of order of rank and value-difference between one person and another and required slavery: indeed without the pathos of distance as it grows out of the ingrained difference between classes, out of the constant looking at and looking down of the ruling caste on subordinates and instruments and out of its likewise constant exercise of commanding, of keeping down and keeping apart, neither could that other more mysterious pathos emerge at all, that craving in the soul for [Page 325] 318 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS every new expansion of distance, the development of ever higher, rarer, more remote, more widespread and comprehensive states, in brief, the “self-overcoming of humanity,” to use a moral formula in a supra-moral sense. One question comes to me again and again, a tempting and wicked question perhaps: let it be whispered in the ears of those who have a right to such questionable questions, the strongest souls of today who also have themselves best under control: would it not be time, the more the type “herd-animal” is now being developed in Europe, to attempt a fundamental artificial and conscious cultivation of the opposing type and its virtues? And would it not be a kind of goal, redemption and justification for the democratic movement itself if someone came along who used it — by finally adding to its new and sublime configuration of slavery, which one day will represent the culmination of European democracy, that higher order of masterful and Caesarian spirits that now also — requires this new slavery? For new vistas heretofore impossible, for their own vistas? For their own tasks?!” 2[14] Our four cardinal virtues: courage, sympathy, insight and solitude — they would be

unbearable to one another if they were not fraternized with a cheerful and mischievous vice called “courtesy.” — 2[15] Cruelty can be the alleviation of tense and proud souls, of those who are accustomed to constantly practicing hardships on themselves; it has become a celebration for them to finally do harm for once, to see suffering — all warlike races are cruel; cruelty can, conversely, also be a kind of saturnalia of oppressed and weak-willed beings, of slaves, of women of the harem, a small tickle of power — there is a cruelty of evil and also a cruelty of bad and negligible souls. [Page 326] 2 AUTUMN 1885—

AUTUMN 1886 319 2[16]’8 What is noble? Belief in order of rank. Work (about artists, scholars etc.) Cheerfulness (symptom of turning out well).! Master morality and herd morality. 2[17] The writings in question, painstakingly and patiently interrogated, may be used as a means to perhaps gain access to an understanding of a still higher and more difficult type than is even (the) type of the free spirit: — no other way leads to the understanding of — — * Writings from the youth of the same author. *The Birth of Tragedy*. 1st edition 1872. 2nd ed. *Unfashionable Observations* 1873—76. 2[18] A god of love could one day say, bored by his virtue: “let’s have a try for once at devilishness!” — and behold, a new origin of evil! From boredom and virtue! — — 2[19]’° “Paradise is under the shadow of swords” — also a symbolon?! and motto by which souls of noble and warlike lineage reveal and divine one another. — 2[20]’2 “Eagles pounce straight-on.” The nobility of the soul is not least recognized by the magnificent and proud stupidity with which it attacks — “straight-on.” 2[21] There is also a squandering of our passions and desires, namely in the modest and petit bourgeois way in which we [Page 327] 320 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS satisfy them: — which ruins our taste, but even more our respect and fear of ourselves. Temporary asceticism is the means to dam them — to give them dangerousness and grand style — — 2[22] With respect to what fruitful spirits require uppermost and undermost, in order to not suffer from the worms of their conscience — namely “lay eggs, cackle, brood eggs” and so forth with or without grace — they may justifiably, as Stendhal and Balzac have done — prescribe a diet of abstinence. And at least one must not doubt that the nuptial bed can be more disastrous for precisely the “genius” than concubinage and libertinage. — Also in many other respects—for example, as concerns “descendants” — one must occasionally take counsel with oneself and resolve: *aut liberi aut libri*.” 2[23] Reflected long about that point of origin of religious genius and consequently also of “metaphysical need,” the “religious neurosis” — reluctantly mindful of that expression famous and even proverbial in France, that reveals so much about the “health” of the French mind: “/e génie est une neurose?” — 2[24]” — And to say it again: the beast in us wants to be ied to — morality is a white lie. 2[25]’° “You seem to be up to something wicked,” I once said to the god Dionysus: “namely driving human beings to ruin?” — “Perhaps,”

replied the god, “but in such a way that I get something out of it for myself” — “What then?” I asked, curious. — “Who then? you should be asking.” Thus spoke Dionysus and he grew silent, in the way that is his own, namely seductively. — You should have seen him then! It was spring, and all the trees were in their early sap. [Page 328] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 321 2[26]?” Beyond Good and Evil. Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future. By Friedrich Nietzsche. 2[27]° Beyond Good and Evil. All Sorts of Things to Ponder for Halcyon Spirits. By Friedrich Nietzsche. 2[28]°? My tolerably radical question mark for all your penal legislation is this: given that the punishments are supposed to hurt in proportion to the magnitude of the crime — and that’s how you all want it at bottom! well, then they would have to be measured for each criminal proportionate to his sensitivity for pain — that is, there should be a pre-existing determination of punishment for an offense, a penal code ought not to exist at all? But, considering that it would not be easy to determine the scale of pleasure and displeasure in a criminal, then in praxi? one would surely have to dispense with punishing? What a loss! Right? Consequently — — 2[29] Music does not reveal the essence of the world and its “will,” as Schopenhauer claimed (who deceived himself about music as he did about compassion, and for the same reason — he knew them both too little from experience —): music reveals [Page 329] 322 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS only the esteemed musicians! And they themselves do not know it! — And how good, perhaps, that they do not know it! — 2[30]* Our Virtues. All Sorts of Questions and Questionable Matters for Subtler Consciences. By Friedrich Nietzsche. Our Virtues. Hints for a Morality of the Future. By Friedrich Nietzsche. On the Strength of the Soul. On Honesty. On Cheerfulness. On the Will to Solitude. “What is Noble?” 2[32]3 The Philosophers of the Future. A Speech. 1. Is such a greatness possible today? — 2. But perhaps tomorrow, perhaps the day after tomorrow. — I see new ph(ilosophers) coming up etc. 2[33] There is a misunderstanding of cheerfulness that cannot be put to rest: but whoever shares it may ultimately be satisfied [Page 33] 26 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS spirits, for which we have the church to thank. — The intellectual pressure of the church is essentially the inflexible rigidity by virtue of which concepts and values are treated as fixed, as *aeternae*. Dante provides us with a singular pleasure in this: one need in no way be limited under an absolute regime. If there were limits, then they were stretched around a tremendous space, thanks to Plato: and within them one could move very freely, like Bach within the forms of counterpoint. — Baco{n} and Shakespeare almost repulse us if we have thoroughly learned to taste this “freedom under the law.” Likewise the most recent music compared to Bach and Handel. 34193] As Frederick the Great constantly ridicules the “féminisme in the regency of his neighbor states, so Bismarck “parliamentarianism”: it is a new means to do what one wants. 66 34194] The sight of today’s European gives me a great deal of

hope: what is taking shape here is a daring ruling race, across the breadth of an extremely intelligent herd mass. It is imminent that the movements for absorption® of the latter no longer stand alone in the foreground. 34[95]°

Against false idealism, where the best natures of the world alienate themselves through exaggerated subtlety. What a shame that the whole of southern Europe has been deprived of its inheritance of that subdued sensuality, by the abstinence of the clergy! And that such Shelleys, Hélderlins, Leopardis are destroyed is fair, I do not regard such people very highly at all. It amuses me to think of the revenge that the rough naturalness of nature takes on this kind of human being e.g., when I hear that L(eopardi) engaged in on(anism) when young, was later impotent. [Page 330] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 323 with it as it is. —

We who flee to happiness — : we who need every kind of south and unruly fullness of sun and position ourselves at that point on the street where life, like a drunken parade of grotesque masks — like something that makes us lose our minds — tumbles past; we who demand of happiness precisely that it makes us “lose our minds”: does it not seem that we have a knowledge that we fear? With which we do not want to be alone? A knowledge before whose pressure we tremble, before whose whispering we blanch? This stiff-necked turning away from sad spectacles, this plugging and hardening of our ears to all suffering, this brave, mocking superficiality, this willful Epicureanism of the heart that wants to have nothing warm and whole and worships the mask as its final divinity and redemptress: this scorn against the melancholic of taste, in whom we always detect a lack of profundity — is not all of this only hatred of life? It seems we know ourselves as all too brittle, perhaps even as shattered and incurable; it seems we fear this hand of life, that it must shatter us, and we flee into its appearance, into its falseness, its surface and colorful deceptiveness; it seems we are cheerful because we are tremendously sad. We are serious, we know the abyss: that is why we resist all that is serious. — — — we smile to ourselves about the melancholics of taste — oh we even envy them, as we mock them! — for we are not happy enough to be able to allow ourselves their delicate sadness. We must flee even the shadow of sadness: our hell and darkness is always too near to us. We have a knowledge that we fear, with which we do not want to be alone; we have a belief before whose pressure we tremble, before whose whispering we blanch — the nonbelievers seem blessed to us. We turn away from the sad spectacles, we plug our ears against whatever suffers, compassion would immediately shatter us if we did know how (to) harden ourselves. Stay boldly at our side, mocking recklessness: cool us, wind, that has sped over [Page 331] 324 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS glaciers: we want to take nothing more to heart, we want to pray to the mask There is something in us that easily shatters: we fear the shattering childish hands? we avoid chance and rescue ourselves — — — 2[34] I loved and honored Richard Wagner more than anyone

else; and if in the end he had not had the bad taste — or the sad need — to make common cause with a quality of “spirits” that were impossible to me, with his followers, the Wagnerians, then I would have had no reason to bid him farewell already in his lifetime: him, the deepest and boldest, also the most misunderstood of all who are hard to understand today, whose acquaintance has advanced my knowledge more than any other acquaintance I have made. Let me say at the beginning what belongs at the beginning, that his cause and my cause did not want to be confused, and that it took a good bit of self-overcoming before I adequately learned to separate “his” and “mine” in the proper measure. That I came to my senses about the extraordinary problem of the actor — a problem that probably is more distant from me than any other, for a reason that is hard to articulate — that I discovered and recognized the actor at the bottom of every artist, that which is typically artistic, for that I needed to come into contact with that (man) — and it seems to me that I think more highly a(nd) more lowly of both than an earlier philos(opher)³⁴ — The improvement of the theater concerns me little, its “churchification” even less; the actual Wagnerian music does not sufficiently belong to me — I would be able to dispense with them for my happiness and for my health (*quod erat demonstrandum et demonstratum*®). What was most foreign to me in him, the Teutonomania and semi-churchiness of his last years — — — [Page 332] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 325 2135] A new way of thinking — which is always a new way of measuring and presupposes the presence of a new standard, a new sensation-scale — feels itself to be in contradiction with old ways of thinking and constantly says, while resisting them, “that is false.” Examined more closely such a “that is false” really only means “I do not feel anything of myself in that,” “it’s of no interest to me,” “I do not comprehend how you are not able to feel as I do” 2[36] On detachment. On hardening. On the mask. On the order of rank. European and super-European. 2137] One always has something more necessary to do than to get married: Heavens, this is what’s always happened to me! 2[38]°° Beyond Good and Evil. Hints at a Morality of the Strongest. 2[39] Mask and Communication. 2[40] The philosophers of the future. On the natural history of the free spirit. Our virtues. Peoples and fatherlands. Defeminization. *homo religiosus*.>’ [Page 333] 326 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 2[41] On the Natural History of the Superior Human. Thoughts of an Educator. 1. The philosophers of yore. 2. Artists and poets. 3. The religious genius. 4. We virtuous ones. 5. Woman. 6. Scholars. 7. The “tempters.” 8. Peoples and fatherlands. 9. Wisdom of the mask. 10. Moral Psychology. Proverbs and dashes.*? What is noble? Appendix. Songs of Prince Vogelfrei. 2[42]° Beyond Good and Evil. Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future. With an appendix: Songs and Arrows of Prince Vogelfrei. By Friedrich Nietzsche. 2143] On the Natural History of the Superior Human. Dashes“? of a Psychologist. 1. The philosopher. 2. The free spirit. 3. The religious genius. 4. On

moral psychology 5. What is noble? [Page 334] 2 AUTUMN 1885-AUTUMN 1886 327 6. Peoples and fatherlands. 7. Woman in herself. 8. Scholars. 9. We virtuous ones. 10. Wisdom and mask. 11. The coming ones. 12. Proverbs of a laconic one. Appendix: Songs and Arrows of Prince Vogelfrei. 2[44] Preface. 1. What was the philosopher? 2. On the natural history of the free spirit. 3. Monologue of a psychologist. 4. Woman in herself. 5. The religious genius. 6. We scholars. 7. We virtuous ones. 8. What is noble? 9. Peoples and fatherlands. 10. The masks. 11. The tempters. Dionysus. Appendix: — — — Table of contents. 2[45] Nothing of the advocate:*? no man of the party; suspicious of that which is called “conviction”; unbelieving toward unbelief; — — — 2[46] On the Natural History of the Superior Human. Thoughts of an Idler. By Friedrich Nietzsche. [Page 335] 328 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS Beyond Good and Evil. Monologues of a Psychologist. With an appendix: Songs and Arrows of Prince Vogelfrei. By Friedrich Nietzsche. Appendix: Songs and Arrows of Prince Vogelfrei. 1. To the mistral. 2. To Goethe. 3. To certain eulogists. 4. Sils-Maria. 5. Hermit’s noon. 6. Toward new seas. 7. “The Pigeons of San Marco” 8. Inscription above the house door. 9. The genuine German. 10. Parsifal music. 11. To Spinoza. 12. Rimus remedium.* 13. Fool in despair. 14. Aftersong. 6 2[48] Woman is so little satisfied with herself that she would rather permit herself to be beaten than — [Page 336] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 329 2[49] In most loves there is someone who plays and someone who lets himself be played with: Amor is above all a little theatre director. 2[50]” Contents: Preface. 1. On the prejudices of philosophers. 2. The free spirit. 3. The religious genius. The religious character. 4. Woman in herself. Proverbs and Interludes. 5. On the natural history of morality. 6. We scholars. “Carcasse, tu trembles? Tu 7. Our virtues. tremblerais bien davantage, 8. Peoples and fatherlands si tu savais, où je te mène? 9. Masks. Turenne*® 10. What is noble? Appendix: Songs and Arrows of Prince Vogelfrei. ais} Monologues of a Psychologist On the Natural history of the superior human.” By Friedrich Nietzsche What is noble?>! 2[52]”? Proverbs and Monologues. With a Rhymed Addition. By Friedrich Nietzsche. [Page 337] 330 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 2[53}°? Beyond Good and Evil Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future. Introduction. First Book: on the prejudices of philosophers. Second Book: hints of a moral-psycholo(gist) Third Book: we Europeans. An opportunity for self-mirroring. also)” Beyond Good and Evil. By Friedrich Nietzsche. alss}” Penultimate chapter Alcuin the Anglo-Saxon, who characterized the royal profession of the philosopher thus: prava corrigere, et recta corroborare, et sancta sublimare.°° 2[56] Corruption of the strong natural human being in the compulsion of the civilized cities (— ends up in the leprous parts, learns bad conscience there) 2[57]°” From now on there will be favorable preconditions for more comprehensive ruling structures, the like of which have

never existed. And this is not even the most important thing; the emergence of international racial federations has been made possible, which set themselves the task of cultivating a rulerrace, the future “rulers of the earth”; — a new, tremendous aristocracy built upon the harshest self-legislation, in which the will of philosophical brutes and artist-tyrants will be given [Page 338] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 331 millennia of longevity: — a superior kind of human being that thanks to its preponderance of willing, knowing, wealth and influence, makes use of democratic Europe as its most pliable and flexible tool for taking the destinies of the earth in hand, for shaping “the human being” itself as an artist would. Enough, the time is coming when people will relearn what politics is. 2[58] I believe we are lacking political passion: we would endure with honors under a demo(cratic) sky just as well as under an abs(olutist) sky. 2[59] For 1 But finally: why must one speak of what will come so loudly and with such wrath! Let us look at it more coolly, distantly, cleverly, from on high, let us say it as it is allowed to be said among us, so secretly that everyone misses it — that everyone misses us... Let it be called a continuation.*® 2[60] What? Drama is the end, music is always only the means? That may be W(agner)’s theory: his practice was opposed to it: the (dramatic) attitude” is the end, the music always only a means to an attitude (to its elucidation, strengthening, internalization —) 2[61]6? The development of the mechanistic-atomistic way of thinking is still not aware of its necessary goal even today; — this is my impression, after scrutinizing its followers for a long time. It will conclude with the creation of a system of signs: it will dispense with explanations, it will give up the concept “cause and effect.” [Page 339] 332 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 2[62]% Not to want to deceive — and not to want to be deceived: this is something fundamentally different as inclination and will, but one tendency like the other is accustomed to using the word “philosophy,” be it as ornament or concealment or out of misunderstanding. 2[63]° The physiologists should stop and think before positing the drive for self-preservation as the cardinal drive of an organic being: something that lives wants above all to discharge its strength: “preservation” is only one of the consequences of this. — Beware of superfluous teleological principles! And that is where the whole concept of “self-preservation” belongs. 2[64]% Every Philoctetes knows that without his bow and his arrows Troy will not be conquered. 2[65]* In media vita. Monologues of a Psychologist. By Friedrich Nietzsche. 2[66]%° — For the preface. — Perhaps a continuation: the artistphilosopher (hitherto scientism, position on religion and politics mentioned): higher concept of art. Whether a human being can position himself so far from other human beings that he is capable of shaping them? (Practice exercises: 1) the one who shapes himself, the hermit 2) the artist so far, as the small completer, on a material® (nol) — to this belongs the series of rank of the superior humans, which must be represented. [Page 34] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885

27 34196]”° NB. A great human being, a human being whom nature built up and invented in grand style, what is that? First: in his entire activity he has a long logic which due to its length is hard to survey, and consequently is misleading, an ability to stretch his will across great expanses of his life and to despise and throw away everything petty in himself, even if among them are the most beautiful “divine” things in the world. Second: he is colder, harder, more unscrupulous and without fear of “opinion”; he lacks the virtues associated with “respect” and being respected, in generally everything that belongs to the “virtue of the herd.” If he cannot /ead, then he goes alone; it then happens that he grunts at many things he encounters along the way. 3) he does not want a “sympathetic” heart, but servants, tools, in his interaction with people he is always out to make something of them. He knows himself to be uncommunicable: he finds it tasteless when he becomes “familiar”; and usually when someone considers him to be so he is not. When he is not talking to himself he has his mask. He would rather lie than tell the truth: it requires more spirit and will. There is a solitude in him, as something unreachable for praise and blame, as a jurisdiction of one’s own, which has no higher court above it. 34197] What I like to perceive in Germans is their Mephistopheles nature: but, to tell the truth, one must have a higher concept of the G(erman) M(ephistopheles) than Goethe, (who) found it necessary to diminish his M(ephistopheles) in order to magnify his “inner Faust.” The true German Mephistopheles is much more dangerous, bolder, more evil, more crafty and therefore more candid: consider the inwardness of Frederick the Great. Or of that much greater Frederick, of that Hohenstaufen Frederick 2. — The genuine German Mephistopheles climbs over the Alps, believes that everything there belongs to Aim. This is why he thrives as Winckelmann thrived, as Mozart. He regards Faust [Page 340] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 333 — One Chapter: Music. — On the theory of “intoxication” (itemization, e.g., worship of petits faits®®) — German and French and Italian music. (Our politically lowest periods the most fruitful: —) the Slavs? — the cultural-historical ballet: — has conquered the opera. — an error, that what was created by Wagner) is a form — it is a formlessness. The possibility of a dramatic structure has yet to be found. Actor-music and musician-music — The rhythmic. Expression at any cost. — in praise of “Carmen” — in praise of H. Schütz (and “Liszt-Verein”® —) — whorish instrumentation — in praise of Mendelssohn: an element of Goethe in him, and nowhere else! just as another element of Goethe came to perfection in Rahel!”° a third in H. Heine’! For the chapter “free spirit.” — 1) I do not want to “glorify” him: a word in favor of the bound spirits. 2) the depravity of the intellect: the proof from pleasure (“it makes me happy, therefore it is true”) Here the vanity of the “me” to be underscored. For the chapter “our virtues”: 3) new form of morality: loyalty oaths in federations regarding what one wants to do and not do, quite specific renunciation of many

things. Tests, to determine whether ripe for this.” — For the chapter “religious genius.” 1) mystery, the exemplary history of a soul (“Drama” — means?) 2) the interpretability of events, belief in “meaning” is maintained thanks to religion — 3) to what extent the higher soul grows and flourishes at the expense of the lower? 4) what has been refuted is the morality of Christianity as essential in the destinies of the world-soul: — yet the will to introduce it and to make it dominant has not yet been abolished. — In the end the latter could only be a [Page 341] 334 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS don-quixoticism anyway: — but this would be no reason to think dismissively of it! 5) to what extent religious genius is a degeneration of the artistic: — the shaping force. 6) to what extent only the artist-conscience provides freedom from “true” and “untrue.” Unconditional “faith” to be transformed into unconditional will — — 7) religious literature, the concept “sacred book.” for “our virtues.” Whatever we can unleash our scientism upon, we no longer take hard and seriously: a kind of immorality. For the chapter “natural history of morality.” Corruption, what is that? E.g., of the natur(al) strong human being who comes into the cities. E.g., of the Fr(en)ch aristocrats, before the French Revolution. For the chapter “Man and Woman.” The triumph of man over woman wherever culture begins. NB: *magister liberalium artium et hilaritatum.*” NB. I have grabbed something by the horns — only I doubt whether it was a steer —” 4 2[67] “P “subject” as horizon-line. Reversal of the perspectival gaze. 2[68]” Using the body as a guide. The self-dividing protoplasma. $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2}$ not = 1, but = 2. (Therewith) the belief in soul monads is invalidated. Self preservation only as one of the consequences of selfexpansion. of one’s “self”? 2[69]’° Mechanical force is known to us only as a sensation of resistance: and the latter is only sensually interpreted with pressure and thrust, not explained. [Page 342] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 335 What kind of compulsion is it that a stronger soul exerts on a weaker? — And it would be possible that the apparent “disobedience” toward the higher soul was based on not understanding its will. e.g., a boulder does not let itself be commanded. But what is needed is precisely a slow differentiation of degree and rank: only the most closely related can understand one another and consequently there can be obedience here. Whether possible to comprehend all motions as signs of a psychic event? Natural science as a symptomatology — It is perhaps wrong, because the life-forms are very small (cells e.g.), now to seek even smaller units, “force-points” etc.? The pre-stage of ruling structures Devotion to the person (father, forefather, prince, priest, God) as alleviation of morality. 2[70]” Beyond Good and Evil — Problem of the lawgiver. Using the body as a guide. Mechanism and life. The will to power. — Interpretation, not knowledge. On doctrine of method. The eternal recurrence. — The artist. Culture and its substructure. — We godless ones. — Music and culture. — On great and small politics. “Mystery.” The good and the just. The vow-makers. — On the history of

pessimism. — Education. [Page 343] 336 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 2[778 On “Zarathustra” Calina: brownish red, everything too sharp from close up. Highest summer. Ghostly Sipo Matador.®° And who says that we do not want this? What music and seduction! There is nothing there that did not poison, lure, corrode, overthrow, revalue! I The decisive moment: The order of rank. 1) Smash the good and just! 2) The eternal recurrence. Noon and Eternity. Book of the Prophet. 2[72]" Noon and Eternity. By F. N. I The festival of the dead. Zarathustra discovers a tremendous festival: II The new order of rank: III On the rulers of the earth. IV On the ring of recurrence. [Page 344] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 337 2[73] The titles of 10 new books: (spring 1886.) Thoughts concerning the Ancient Greeks. By Friedrich Nietzsche. How in becoming everything degenerates and becomes unnatural. The degeneration of the Renaissance — of philology Example of the immoral basic conditions of a higher culture, of an elevation of the human being. The Will to Power. Attempt at a New World-Interpretation.® The Artists. Ulterior Motives of a Psychologist By Friedrich Nietzsche. We Godless Ones By Friedrich Nietzsche Noon and Eternity.*4 By Friedrich Nietzsche Beyond Good and Evil. Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future.® By Friedrich Nietzsche. Gai Saber. Songs of Prince Vogelfrei.®° By Friedrich Nietzsche. [Page 345] 338 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS Music. By Friedrich Nietzsche Experiences of a Literary Scribe. °° By Friedrich Nietzsche. On the History of Modern Dimming.®® By Friedrich Nietzsche. 2[74]° The Will to Power. 1. Physiology of Order of Rank. 2. The Great Noon. 3. Discipline and Cultivation. 4. The Eternal Recurrence. 2[75]° The Eternal Recurrence. Book of new festivals and prophecies. The Eternal Recurrence. Sacred dances and vows. Noon and Eternity. Sacred dances of the recurrsers. 2[76]" (28) On the Order of Rank: For I. On the Physiology of Power. Aristocracy in the body, the majority of the rulers (struggle of the tissues? Slavery and the division of labor: the higher ty pe only possible through the suppression of a lower type to a mere function [Page 346] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 339 Pleasure and pain not opposite. The feeling of power. Nourishment only a consequence of insatiable appropriation, of the will to power. Reproduction, decay setting in with the impotence of the ruling cells to organize what has been appropriated." It is the shaping force that always wants to have a new supply of “material” (still more “force”). The masterpiece of the construction of an organism from the egg. “Mechanistic conception”: wants nothing but quantities: but force lies in quality: mechanistics therefore can only describe, not explain processes. “Purpose.” One should proceed from the “sagacity” of plants. Concept of “perfection”: not only greater complexity, but greater power (— need not be only greater mass —) Conclusion regarding the development of humanity: perfection consists in the production of the most powerful individuals, who wield the greatest masses as their tool (and indeed as

the most intelligent and flexible tool)? Artists as the small shapers. The pedantry of “educators” by comparison Punishment: the up-holding™ of a higher type. Isolation. Wrong lessons from history. Because something high did not turn out well or was abused (like the aristocracy) does not mean it is refuted! 277] The appearance of the empty and the full, of the firm and the loose, of the resting and the moved and of the equal and the unequal. (absolute space the oldest appearance has been made into metaphysics. (substance) — : the human-animalistic security-value standards are in there. [Page 347] 340

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS Our concepts are inspired by our neediness. The positing of opposites corresponds with indolence (one differentiation that suffices for nourishment, security etc. is regarded as “true”) — simplex veritas! — Thought from indolence. Our values are interpreted into things. So is there a meaning in the in-itself?? Is not meaning necessarily but relational-meaning and perspective? All meaning is will to power (all relational-meanings can be dissolved in it.) A thing = its properties = but these like everything that concerns us about this thing: a unity, under which we summarize those relations that come into question for us. At bottom the changes that we have perceived in ourselves (— except those that we do not perceive e.g., its electricity). In sum: Object is the sum of experienced inhibitions of which we have become aware. A property therefore always expresses something of “useful” or “harmful” for us. Colors e.g., — each one corresponds to a degree of pleasure or displeasure and each degree of pleasure and displeasure is the result of valuations about “useful” and “not useful.” — Disgust. 2[78]* Themata. Interpretation, not explanation. Reduction of logical value judgments to moral and political (value of security, of peace, of laziness (“least energy”) etc. The problem of the artist, his morality (lies, shamelessness, inventiveness for what he lacks). The slandering of immoral drives: regarded in consequence a denial of life. The absolute and where the ideal features come from that are attributed to it. Punishment as a means of cultivating. [Page 348] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 341 Gravitation interpretable in many ways: like everything allegedly “factual.” The predicate expresses an effect that is produced upon us (or could be) not the effect in itself; the sum of predicates is summarized into a single word. Error, that the subject is supposed to be causa. — Mythology of the subject-concept. (“lightning” flashes — doubling — the effect objectifies. Mythology of the causality-concept. Separation of “effecting” and “agent” fundamentally wrong. The appearance of what remains unchanged, now as before — — Our European culture — toward what does it hurry, as opposed to the Buddhistic dissolution in Asia? Religion, essentially doctrine of order of rank, even attempt at a cosmic order of rank and power. weakness lies, dissimulation stupidity lust to rule to what extent idealizing? curiosity greed cruelty 2[79] My writings are very well defended: whoever reaches for them and ends up over-reaching as someone who has no right to such

books — he immediately makes himself ridiculous — a little fit of rage drives him to pour out his innermost and his most ridiculous: and who wouldn't know what kinds of things always come out here! Little literary women as they tend to be, with pathological sexual organs and with ink stains on their fingers — The inability to see the new and the original: the clumsy fingers that do not know how to grasp a nuance, the stiff earnestness that stumbles over a word and falls down: the shortsightedness that intensifies to blindness before the tremendous realm of distant landscapes [Page 349] 342 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS

Have I ever complained about my fate, about being read too little and understood so poorly? But for how many may something extraordinary be created anyway! — Do you think that God created the world for the sake of humans? 2[80]? For the introduction. The gloomy solitude and dreariness of the *campagna Romana*,^o ° patience in uncertainty Every book as a conquest, good decision — *tempo lento*! — — until the end dramatically coiled, ultimately catastrophe and sudden redemption. 2[81]!020 (15) It is only a matter of strength: have all the pathological features of the century, but balance them in a superabundant plastic restorative force. The strong human being: description 2[82]!°4 Beyond Good and Evil. Second and Final Part Preface. Interpretation, not explanation. There are no factual findings, everything is fluid, ungraspable, retreating; what is most durable is still our opinions. Attaching meaning — in most cases a new interpretation over an old interpretation that has become incomprehensible, that itself is now only sign.!!% On the physiology of power. A consideration according to which the human being feels his strongest drives and his ideals (and his good conscience) as identical. We godless ones. What are artists? Justice and lawgiving. On the history of modern dimming. [Page 35] 28 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS and Hamlet's caricatures invented for ridicule, likewise Luther. Goethe had good German moments in which he laughed inwardly about all that. But then he himself fell back into the humid moods. The astonishment of Napoleon when he saw a German poet and — found a man! He had expected to find a German poet!"! — The German is extensive: a second soul has built itself onto the first, there are caves, corridors, he can appear superficial, frankness and decency belong to the skills of the German. — "Good-natured and devious" is an impossibility in other p(eople); but just try living for a time among Swabians! — 34[98] An age of democracy propels the actor to the heights, in Athens, likewise as today. R(ichard) W(agner) has so far surpassed everyone in this, and awakened a high concept of the actor, which can be awe-inspiring. Music, poetry, religion, culture, books, family, fatherland, social life — all art for the time being, that is to say stage attitude! 34[99] Pig-German! Excuse me! Newspaper-German! Here (I) read Friedrich Albert Lange, a good horse whom one should even recommend to German youths in the absence of better horses: but he writes for example: "The cult of reality binds itself with the praise of the present. What

is ideal has no course; whatever cannot legitimize itself through the natural sciences and historically is condemned to decline.”? Why do we learn Latin and Greek in German schools anyway: if we do not even learn to be disgusted by such a filthy mishmash! And what enthusiasm precisely the real German spoilers have aroused, formerly Hegel, more recently Richard Wagner, most recently Eugen Diihring! 34[100] It is terrifying to think that my thoughts on woman could drive some lady writer to the vengeful idea of having children [Page 350] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 343 Acting. On the good and the just. Rank and order of rank. To the mistral. A dance song. Beyond good and evil as brightening for a few as deepest dimming for many. On the history of modern dimming. Psychology of the artist. On acting. The problem of the lawgiver. Danger in music. Interpretation, not knowledge. The good and the just. On great and small politics. We godless ones. To the Mistral. Dance Song. In 30 pages. 2 folios. (Preface: what my writings have in common) Interpretation, not explanation. On the physiology of power. On acting On the history of modern dimming We godless ones. The good and the just. On order of rank. Justice and lawgiving. Artists 2[83]!°° (7) The human being regards himself as cause, as doer — everything that happens relates predicatively to some subject In every judgment resides the entire full profound belief in subject and predicate or in cause and effect; and this latter [Page 351] 344 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS belief (namely as the claim that every effect is activity and that every activity presupposes an actor)!” is even only an individual case of the former, so that what remains is the belief as basic belief: subjects exist. I observe something and look for a reason for it: originally this means: I am looking for an intention in it and above all for one that has intentions, for a subject, a doer: — formerly one saw purposes in a// events, all events were a doing. This is our oldest habit. Do animals have it too? Are they not, as living beings, also dependent on interpretation according to themselves? — The question “why?” is always a question about the *causa finalis*,” about a “what for?” We have nothing of a “meaning of the *causa efficiens*”)© here Hume is right, habit (but not only that of the individual!) leads us to expect that a certain frequently observed process follows on another: nothing more! What gives us our extraordinary firmness in the belief in causality is not the great habit of succession of events, but our inability to interpret an event as anything but an event from intentions. It is the belief in what lives and thinks as uniquely effective — in the will, intention — that all events are a doing, that all doing presupposes a doer, it is the belief in the “subject.” Shouldn’t this belief in the subject- and predicateconcept be a big s(tupidity)? Question: is intention the cause of an event? Or is that illusion too? Is it not the event itself?! “Attracting” and “repelling” in a purely mechanical sense is a complete fiction: a word. Without an intention we cannot conceive an attracting: i.e., without an intention. — The will to master a thing or to resist its

power and push it back — that “we understand”: that would be an interpretation that we could use. Briefly: the psychological necessity for a belief in causality lies in the inconceivability of an event without intentions: which naturally says nothing about truth or untruth (justification of such a belief). The belief in causae!!! falls with the belief in téAn!? (against Spinoza and his causalism).!!% [Page 352] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 345 2[84]!!4115 (30) Judging is our oldest belief, our most habituated holding-true or holding-untrue of something. In judgment is found our oldest belief, in all judging there is a holding-true or a holding-untrue, an affirming or denying, a certainty that something is so and not otherwise, a belief that we have really “known” something here — what is believed as true in all judging? What are predicate? — We have taken changes in ourselves not as such, but as an “in itself” that is foreign to us, that we only “perceive”: and we have posited them not as an event, but as a being, as “property” — and we have added the invention to which they stick. ž.e., we have posited effect as effecting and the effecting as being. But even in this formulation the concept “effect” is arbitrary: for of those changes that occur in us and of which we believe ourselves definitely not to be the cause, we infer only that they must be effects: according to the conclusion: “to every change belongs an author;” — But this conclusion is already mythology: it separates the effecting and the effect. When I say “the lightning flashes,” then I have posited the flashing once as activity and the other time as subject: hence I have supposed a being beneath the event, which is not one with the event, but on the contrary remains, is, and does not “become.” — To posit the event as effect: and the effect as being: this is the double error, or interpretation, of which we make ourselves guilty. Therefore e.g., “the lightning flashes” — : “flashing” is a state in us: but we do not take it as effect on us, and say: “something flashing” as an “in itself” and seek an author for it, the “lightning.” 2[85]11617 (32) The properties of a thing are effects on other “things”: if one thinks away other “things,” then a thing has no properties i.e., there is no thing without other things i.e., there is no “thing in itself” [Page 353] 346 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 2[86]!!8119 (30) Only what can knowledge be? — “Interpretation,” not “explanation.” 21871” (32) All unity is only unity as organization and interplay: no different than a human community is a unity: therefore opposite of atomistic anarchy; hence a ruling-structure that signifies One, but is not one.!?”! One would have to know what being is, in order to decide whether this and that is real (e.g., “the facts of consciousness”); likewise what certainty is, what knowledge is and so forth. — But since we do not know this, then a critique of the faculty of knowledge is nonsensical: how is the tool supposed to be able to critique itself, if it can use only itself for critiquing? It cannot even define itself !!? If all unity is unity only as organization? but the “thing” in which we believe is only added as an invention to different predicates as ferment. When a thing “effects,” then this

means: we comprehend as cause all remaining properties that otherwise are still present here and are momentarily latent, so that now a single property appears: i.e., we take the sum of its properties — x as cause of the property x: which is entirely stupid and crazy!!”³ “The subject” or the “thing” 2[88]!24 (33) A force that we cannot imagine (like the so-called purely mechanical force of attraction and repulsion) is an empty word and should not have any rights of citizenship in science: which wants to make the world imaginable to us, nothing more!!” All events from intentions are reducible to the intention of increase of power.)^{*o} [Page 354] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 347 2[89]!27 Illusion that something *és* known where we have a mathematical formula for events: it has only been characterized, described: nothing more! 2[90]128129 (31) Equality and similarity. 1) the cruder organ sees much apparent equality 2) the mind wants equality i.e., to subsume a sensory impression under an existing series: just as it assimilates the inorganic to itself. On the understanding of logic::: the will to equality is the will to power. — the belief that something is so and so, the essence of judgment, is the consequence of a will that it shall be as much as possible equal. 2[ox]!30131 (30) If our “ego” is for us the sole being according to which we make or understand all being: very good! then the doubt is very well justified whether here a perspectival illusion does not exist — the apparent unity in which everything closes together as in a line of a horizon. Using the body as a guide reveals a tremendous multiplicity; it is methodologically permissible to use the better-studiable richer phenomenon as a guide for understanding the poorer. Finally: supposing everything is becoming, then knowledge is only possible on the basis of the belief in being. [Page 355] 348 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 2[92]! Sense perceptions projected “outward”: “inward” and “outward” — there the body commands — ? — the same equalizing and ordering force that reigns in germ plasm also reigns in the incorporating of the external world: our sense perceptions are already the result of this assimilation and equating with respect to the whole past in us; they do not follow immediately upon the “impression” — 2[93]}33134 (34) To what extent dialectic and faith in reason still rest on moral prejudices. With Plato we are as erstwhile inhabitants of an intelligible world of the good still in possession of a legacy of that period: divine dialectic, as deriving from the good, leads to all things good. (— therefore “leads back” as it were —) Even Descartes had a concept of how in a Christian-moral fundamental way of thinking, which believes in a good God as creator of things, only the truthfulness of God vouches for our sensory judgments. Aside from a religious sanction and vouching for our senses and rationality — where are we supposed to have gotten our right to trust existence! That thinking is supposed to be a measure of the real — that what cannot be thought *és* not — is a clumsy *non plus ultra*!” of a moralistic blind confidence (in an essential truth-principle at the basis of things), in itself an insane assertion that is contradicted in every moment by our

experience. We can actually think nothing at all, insofar as it is... 2[94] We are bad enough at observing the emergence of a judgment of quality Reduction of qualities to value judgments. 2[95]!°° Our perceptions as we understand them: i.e., the sum of all those perceptions whose realization was useful and essential to [Page 356] 2 AUTUMN I—AUTUMN 1886 349 us and to the entire organic process before us: therefore not all perceptions generally (e.g., not the electrical) This means: we have senses only for a selection of perceptions — those that must have been of consequence to us for our survival. Consciousness exists to the extent that consciousness is useful. There is no doubt that all sensory perceptions are completely permeated with value judgments (useful harmful — consequently pleasant or unpleasant) The individual color simultaneously expresses a value for us (although we seldom admit this to ourselves, or only after long exclusive exposure to the same color (e.g., prisoners in prison or insane people)) This is why insects react differently to different colors: some love them e.g. ants. 2[96]!°° Irony toward those who believe Christianity has been overcome by the modern natural sciences. The Christian value judgments are absolutely not overcome by them. “Christ on the cross” is the most sublime symbol — still. — 2[97]!°8 Health and sickness: one should be cautious! The standard remains the efflorescence of the body, the pouncing force, courage and merriness of the spirit — but, naturally also, how much sickness it can take upon itself (and) overcome — make healthy again. That which would ruin more delicate human beings belongs to the stimulants of great health. 2[98]!39!40 (35) Poverty, humility and chastity — dangerous and slanderous ideals, but, like poisons, in the case of certain illnesses, useful remedies e.g., in the Roman imperial age. All ideals are dangerous because they debase and stigmatize the actual, all are poisons, but as occasional remedies indispensable [Page 357] 350 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 2[99]!*) How has the entire organic process behaved toward the rest of nature? — There its basic will reveals itself. 2[100]!42 The Will to Power. Attempt at a Revaluation of all Values. In four Books. First Book: the danger of dangers (description of nihilism) (as the necessary consequence of previous valuations) Second Book: critique of values (of logic etc. Third Book: the problem of the lawgiver (including the history of solitude) How must human beings be constituted who make inverse valuations? — Human beings who have all the properties of the modern soul but are strong enough to transform them into sheer health.!43 Fourth Book: the hammer their means to their task. —“4 Sils-Maria, summer 1886 Tremendous powers are unleashed: but contradicting themselves the unleashed forces are mutually annihilating themselves the unleashed forces are to be newly bound, so that they do not mutually annihilate each other and our eyes have to be opened to the real increase in power! [Page 358] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 351 Everywhere highlight the disharmony between the ideal and its individual

conditions (e.g., honesty among Christians, who are constantly compelled to lying) For Book 2. In democratic communities, where everyone is a specialist, what is lacking is the What for? For whom? the class in which all the thousandfold atrophying of all individuals (to functions) acquires meaning. The development of sensuality cruelty mim ok to the sum of folly ged culture. lust to rule etc. On The danger in all previous ideals Critique of Indian and Chinese way of thinking, likewise Christian (as preparations for a nihilistic one —) The danger of dangers: Everything has no meaning. (2) The hammer: a teaching that achieves a selection of those fittest for life through unleashing of the most death-crazed pessimism 2[101] The inference from the work to the creator: the terrible question of whether fullness or renunciation, the madness of renouncing pushes to creation: the sudden eye for the fact that every romantic ideal is a self-escape, a self-contempt and self condemnation of the one who invents it. [Page 359] 352 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS Ultimately it is a matter of strength: this entire romantic art could be rechanneled entirely into the antiromantic by a super-rich and mighty-willed artist or — to use my formula — into the Dionysian, just as in the hands of the strongest every kind of pessimism and nihilism becomes only one more hammer and tool with which one mounts a new pair of wings on oneself. I recognized with a single glance that Wagner had reached his goal, to be sure, but only as Napoleon had reached his Moscow — at every stage so much had been lost, irretrievably lost, that precisely at the end of the whole march and apparently in the moment of triumph, his fate was already decided. Fateful the verses of Briin(n)hilde — thus Napoleon came to Moscow (R. Wagner to Bayreuth —) To not ally oneself with any sickly powers who are conquered from the start — If I had trusted myself more: the Wagner(ian) inability to walk (even more to dance —and without dance there is for me no recreation and bliss) was always difficult for me. The demand for complete passions is revealing: whoever is capable of them demands the magic of the opposite i.e., of skepticism. Those who are believers through and through have their occasional benefit and recreation in skepticism. Wagner speaking about the delights that he knew how to coax from the Christian Holy Communion: this was decisive for me, I regarded him as conquered. — Add to this that a suspicion arose in me, whether he did not consider it useful for the purpose of his repatriation to Germany, to play the role somewhat of Christian and neoconvert: this suspicion damaged him with me even more than my annoyance at having placed my hopes on an aging romantic whose knees were already weary enough to fall down before the cross. [Page 36] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 29 after she has already tortured herself and the world sufficiently with her books! 34 [101] “When a woman wants to have children, she usually does not let the little children come to her, but the men!”” said an old midwife. 34[102]”4 — We should pay attention to whether what the Germans call their literature does not for the best part hark

back to their pastors' sons. — Now from the start in this origin of German prose lies the probability that the solemn, dignified, s/ow, grave genres have been cultivated best: that *allegro* or even *presto* will be missing. The extraordinary vivaciousness of a style, like *il principe* (quite apart from the seriousness of its task), the brevity strength, a kind of joy in the thronging of difficult thoughts, gives an echo of Florentine eloquence, namely of advocates. In Voltaire too the advocate's skill is first rate, advocate's tempo. The fastest tempo I found in a writer is in Petronius: he runs like a swift wind and consequently is not lascivious: he is too funny for that. 34[103]” The Germans. Suspicions and Desires by F. N. 34[104]” NB. The only Germans of whom I am speaking here, are something young and becoming: I separate them from the Germans of the Reformation and the Th(irty Years) War and do not wish to participate in the historical falsification that ignores this chasm: as if nothing had happened back then. That something like the decline of an earlier race was going on with them in the [Page 360] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 353 2[102]!45 Belief in the body is more fundamental than belief in the soul: the latter has emerged from the aporias of unscientific observation of the body (something that leaves it. Belief in the truth of dreams —) 2[103] Mistrust of self observation. That a thought is the cause of a thought cannot be determined. On the table of our consciousness a sequence of thoughts appears, as if one thought were the cause of the following. In fact we do not see the struggle that plays out beneath the table. — — 2l o 4] 146 With Plato as with someone of super-irritable sensuality and fanaticism the charm of concepts was so great that he involuntarily honored and deified concepts as an ideal form. Dialecticdrunkenness, as the awareness of exerting a mastery over oneself by using it — as a tool of the power will. 2[105]! 4” Pressure and stress something unspeakably late, derivative, unoriginal. They already presuppose something that holds together and is able to pressure and stress! But from where would it hold together? 2[106] The significance of German philosophy (Hegel): to think up a pantheism in which evil, error and suffering are not perceived as arguments against divinity. This grandiose initiative has been misused by the existing powers (state etc.), as if the rationality of whatever happened to rule at the time was thereby sanctioned. Schopenhauer by contrast appears as the obstinate moral human being who finally becomes a world-denier in order to [Page 361] 354 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS be right about his moral(istic) estimation. Finally becomes a “mystic.” I myself have attempted an aesthetic justification: how is the ugliness of the world possible? — I took the will to beauty, to persisting in the same forms, as a temporary means of preservation and healing; but fundamentally the eternally creative as that which must eternally destroy seemed to me bound to pain. The ugly is the form of observation of things under the will to posit a meaning, a new meaning into what has become meaningless: the accumulated force that compels the creator to feel

previous things as untenable, misshapen, worthy of renunciation, as ugly? —!48 The deception of Apollo: the eternity of the beautiful form; the aristocratic law-giving “thus it shall always be!” Dionysus: sensuality and cruelty. Transitoriness could be interpreted as enjoyment of the begetting and destroying force, as constant creation.” 2[107]!5° NB. Religions perish from the belief in morality: the Christian-moral God is not sustainable: consequently “atheism” — as if there could be no other kind of gods. Likewise culture perishes from the belief in morality: for when the necessary conditions from which it alone grows are discovered, then one no longer wants it: Buddhism. 2[108]>! That the value of the world lies in our interpretation (— that perhaps somewhere yet other interpretations than merely human ones are possible —) that the interpretations so far are perspectival valuations by virtue of which we sustain ourselves in life, that is in the will to power, for the growth of power, that every elevation of human beings brings with it the overcoming of narrower interpretations, that every achieved strengthening [Page 362] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 355 and expansion of power opens up new perspectives and means believing in new horizons — this runs through my writings. The world that concerns us is false i.e., is not a fact, but a fiction and a rounding based on a meager sum of observations; it is “in flux,” as something becoming, as a falseness that is ever-shifting, that never approaches truth: for — there is no “truth.” 2[109]’ The “meaninglessness of events”: belief in it is the result of an insight into the falseness of interpretations so far, a generalization of discouragement and weakness — not a necessary belief. Immodesty of human beings: where they do not see meaning, they deny it! 2[110]’53 On “The Birth of Tragedy.” “Being” as the invention of the one who suffers from becoming. A book constructed exclusively from experiences about aesthetic pleasure and displeasure, with an artistic metaphysics in the background. At the same time a confession of a romantic, finally a work of youth full of youthful courage and melancholy. The one who suffers most longs most profoundly for beauty — he begets it. Psychological basic experiences: with the name “Apollonian” is designated that enchanted tarrying before an invented and dreamed world, before the world of beautiful appearance as a redemption from becoming: baptized with the name of Dionysus, on the other hand, is becoming apprehended actively, subjectively empathized, out of raging lust of the creator who simultaneously knows the wrath of the destroyer. Antagonism of these two experiences and the desires on which they are based: the former wants appearance eternally, before it the human being becomes still, wishless, smooth as the sea, healed, in agreement with himself and all existence: the second desire pushes toward becoming, to the lust of making becoming i.e., of creating and annihilating. [Page 363] 356 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS Becoming, perceived and interpreted from the inside, would be the incessant creating of an insatiable, super-rich, infinitely

tensed and pressured being, of a god who conquers the agony of being only through constant transformation and change: — appearance as his temporary redemption, achieved in every moment; the world as the resulting sequence of divine visions and redemptions in appearance. — This artistic metaphysics faces up to the one-sided observation of Schopenhauer, which knows how to appreciate art only from the standpoint of the receiver, not from the standpoint of the artist: because it brings with it liberation and redemption in the enjoyment of the notreal, as opposed to reality (the experience of someone who suffers from and despairs over himself and his reality) — redemption in form and its eternity (as Plato may have also experienced it: except that concepts already permitted him to enjoy the triumph of his all too irritable and suffering sensibility) This is set against the second fact, art from the experience of the artist, above all the musician: the torture of having to create, as Dionysian drive. Tragic art, rich in both experiences, is characterized as the reconciliation of Apollo and Dionysus: appearance is granted the deepest significance, through Dionysus: and yet this appearance is denied and denied with pleasure. This is aimed at Schopenhauer's teaching of resignation as tragic worldview. Against Wagner's theory that music is the means and drama is the end. A longing for tragic myth (for "religion" and indeed pessimistic religion) (as for an isolating cloche in which growing thrives) Mistrust of science: even though its momentary alleviating optimism is strongly perceived. "Cheerfulness of the theoretical human being. Profound aversion to Christianity: why? The degeneration of the German character is imputed to it. Only aesthetically is there a justification of the world. Thorough suspicion of morality (it belongs in the world of appearance). [Page 364] 2 AUTUMN I—AUTUMN 1886 357 Happiness in existence is only possible as happiness in appearance Happiness in becoming is only possible in the annihilation of the real of "existence," of beautiful appearance, in the pessimistic destruction of illusion. in the annihilation of even the most beautiful appearance Dionysian happiness reaches its pinnacle. 2[111] The problem of the meaning of art: why art? How did the most vitally robust and best-formed human beings the Greeks relate to art? Fact: tragedy belongs to their richest period of strength — why? Second fact: the need for beauty; likewise for logicizing the world belong to their decadence Interpretation of both facts: — — — Erroneous practical application to the present: I interpreted pessimism as the consequence of higher strength and fullness of life, which can allow itself the luxury of the tragic. Likewise I interpreted German music as the expression of a Dionysian superabundance and originality i.e., 1) I overestimated the German character 2) I did not understand the sources of modern dimming 3) I lacked the cultural-historical understanding of the origin of modern music and its essential romanticism. Aside from this erroneous practical application the problem persists: how would a music be, if it were not of romantic origin — but of a Dionysian instead? 2[112]4 a romantic is

an artist who is made creative by the great displeasure in himself — who looks away and looks back from himself and his contemporaries [Page 365] 358
 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 2[113]55 I began with a metaphysical hypothesis about the meaning of music: but what underlay it was a psychological experience to which I was not yet able to impute a sufficiently historical explanation. The transference of music into the metaphysical was an act of reverence and gratitude; at bottom all religious persons so far have done this with their experience. — Then came the other side: the undeniably harmful and destructive effect of precisely this venerated music on me — and therewith also the end of its religious veneration. Here too my eyes were opened to the modern need for music (which appears simultaneously in history with the increasing need for narcotics) Even the “Artwork of the Future” seemed to me like a raffinement” of the need for stimulation and narcotization whereby all the senses want to settle their account at the same time, including the idealistic, religious, hypermoral nonsense — as an overall-excitation of the entire nervous machinery. The nature of Romanticism dawned on me: the lack of a fruitful kind of human being has become reproductive here. At the same time the thespianism of means, the fakeness and borrowedness of all individual elements, the lack of probity of artistic education, the abysmal falseness of this most modern art: which essentially must be theater-art. The psychological impossibility of these alleged hero- and god-souls, which are simultaneously nervous, brutal and refined like the most modern of Parisian painters and poets. — Enough, I relegated this art to modern “barbarism.” — All this says nothing about the Dionysian. In the period of greatest fullness and health tragedy appears, but also in the period of nervous exhaustion and overstimulation. Contrasting interpretation. — With Wagner it is characteristic that he already gave the Ring of the Nibelung a nihilistic (calm- and end-craving) conclusion. 20114} The artwork where it appears without artist e.g., as body, as organization (Prussian officer corps, Jesuit order). To what [Page 366] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 359 extent the artist is only a pre-stage.!°* What is the meaning of “subject” — ? The world as an artwork that gives birth to itself — —!° Is art a consequence of our dissatisfaction with reality? Or an expression of gratitude about savored happiness? In the first case Romanticism, in the second halo and dithyramb (in brief apotheosis-art): Raphael belongs here too, only he had the falseness of deifying the appearance of the Christian world interpretation. He was grateful for existence where it did not manifest itself as specifically Christian. With the moralistic) interpretation the world is unbearable. Christianity was the attempt to “overcome” the world with it: that is to negate it. — In praxi!® such an attack of insanity — of an insane arrogance of human beings in the face of the world — led (to) dimming, shrinking, impoverishing of the human being: only the most mediocre and innocuous type, the herdtype of human being, profited from this, was advanced

by this, if you will... Homer as apotheosis-artist; Rubens too. Music has not yet had one. The idealization of the great desecrator (the sense for his greatness) is Greek; the deprecating, slandering, rendering despicable of the sinner, is Jewish a(nd) Christian.!

2[116] That self-knowledge that is modesty — for we are not our own work — but that is also gratitude to the same exact extent — for we “turned out well” — 2117] Psychology of the scientific need. Art from gratitude or dissatisfaction. [Page 367] 360 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS The moral world-interpretation ends in world negation (critique of Christianity). Antagonism between “improvement” and strengthening of the type human being. Infinite interpretability of the world: every interpretation a symptom of growth or of decline.!

The previous attempts to overcome the moral God (pantheism Hegel etc.) Unity (monism) a need of inertia; the plurality of interpretation a sign of strength. Not to want to dispute the world’s unsettling and enigmatic character!! 2[118] i (I. Nihilism in all its signs is at the door. © \ II. Unavoidable, in the event that one does not understand its prerequisites. These are the valuations (not the social facts: which all act alternately pessimistic and optimistic only through a specific interpretation) 2. III. Genesis of valuations, as critique of the same. The inverse ones. Their psychology. V. The hammer: as the teaching that leads to decision. < 1. The danger of dangers. 2. Critique of morality. 3. We inverse ones. 4. The hammer. 2[119] “How far does art reach into the inside of the world? And are there still artistic forces aside from the ‘artist’?” This question was, as one knows, my point of departure: and I said yes to the second question; and to the first “the world itself is nothing but art.” The absolute will to knowledge, to truth and wisdom seemed to me in such a world of appearance to be a sacrilege against (the) metaphysical basic will, as anti-nature: and in fair [Page 368] 2 AUTUMN I—AUTUMN 1886 361 ness (the) sharp point of “wisdom” turns itself against the wise man. The anti-naturalness of wisdom reveals itself in its hostility to art: wanting to know where appearance is precisely redemption — what a reversal, what an instinct for nothingness! 2[120] All cults establish a unique experience, the coming together with a god, an “act of salvation” in some sense; and they repeatedly reproduce it. The legend of place as the origin of a drama: where poetry plays the god. 2[121]!64165 (38) Histronics The colorful motley of the modern human being and its allure. Essentially hiding place and satiety. The literary man. The politician (in the “nationalist swindle”) Histronics in the arts lack of probity in preparatory training and schooling (Fromentin) the romantics (lack of philosophy and science and excess of literature) the novelists (Walter Scott, but also the Nibelung-monstrosities with their most nervous music) the lyricists “Scientism” Virtuosos (Jews) the populist ideals as overcome but not yet visible to the people: the saint, the wise man, the prophet 2[122]!66167 (37) On the history of modern

dimming. The state-nomads (officials etc.): without “homeland” — The decline of the family. [Page 369] 362 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS “The good human being” as symptom of exhaustion. Justice as will to power (cultivation) Lasciviousness and neurosis. Black music; — whither invigorating music? The anarchist. Misanthropy. Disgust. Deepest distinction: whether hunger or superabundance becomes creative? The former begets the ideals of romanticism. northern unnaturalness. the need for alcoholic beverages in the “plight” of workers philosophical nihilism. 2[123] Christians must believe in the truthfulness of God: here unfortunately they also get the belief in the Bible and in its “natural science” in the bargain; they absolutely may not admit to any relative truth (or said more plainly,). Christianity will shatter from the absolute character of its morality. — Science has awakened doubt in the truthfulness of the Christian God: from this doubt Christianity will die (Pascal’s *deus absconditus*®), *afr*}’® 1. Birth of Tragedy. Artists metaphysics. 2. Unfashionable The cultural philistine. Disgust.!”° Observations. Life and history — basic problem. The philosophical hermit. “Education.” The artist-hermit. What is to be learned in W(agner). 3. Human, All The free spirit. Too Human. 4. Mixed Opinions The pessimist of the intellect. and Maxims. (7) Causality. “Why am I thus and such? The senseless thought of thinking oneself free to choose one’s existence, even one’s [Page 37] 30 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 16th century is difficult to deny: this appearance of discouragement, of cowardice, of extreme old age, of the Chinese pigtail, to speak metaphorically — on the whole that must have been the result of a terrible corruption of the blood considering that the manly men went off and away into foreign lands and died or were ruined in foreign lands. On the other hand at that time an involuntary mixing with remotely related races took place: the fornication of war was disastrous beyond measure according to all descriptions. Here and there of course there were still remnants of a stronger race: e.g., the musician Handel, our most beautiful type of man in the realm of art, is proof of that: or, to name a woman — Professor Gottsched’s wife, who with complete justification held the scepter for a good long time over German professors — just look at the portraits of those two! Some regions purified themselves more quickly and on the whole returned to health, e.g., Hannover Westphalia Holstein — there still to this day sits a sturdy peasantlike and phlegmatic race. — The worst off were surely the German nobility: it was damaged most profoundly. Whatever of it remained at home suffered from alcoholism, what went away and came back, from syphilis. To this day it has spoken only little in spiritual matters; and even as concerns Bismarck, his great grandmother came from the Leipzig professor class. — 34[105]*° The German — not to mention the idiotic Teutonizing of youths who even today still prattle about “Teutonic virtues” — his mystical nature. There has never yet been a German culture: there were hermits who knew how to disguise themselves with

astonishing skill, in the midst of the crudest barbarism. 34[106]*! The German writing style. Mephistopheles. [Page 370] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 363 being thus and such. Background: the demand that there must be a being that would have prevented a self-despising creature such as I am from emerging. To fee/ oneself as the counter-argument to God — 5. Wanderer and Solitude, as problem. Shadow. 6. Dawn. Morality as a sum of prejudices 7. Joyful Science. Scorn of European moralistics. Outlook toward an overcoming of morality. How would a human have to be constituted, who lived beyond? Zarathustra) — — — Seven Prefaces. An Addendum to Seven Publications. 2[125]'7 On the history of pessimism. Modern dimming. Histrionics. 2[126]'72 For 2) Critique of the highest values. On the history of slandering. How ideals are made. Culture (and “humanization”: antagonistic) Morality as instinct of shame, as disguise, mask, fundamentally benevolent interpretation (37) Mix in judgments about the pessimists! The Indians Pessimism (as instinct) and the will to pessimism: major contrast [Page 371] 364 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS The pessimist of the intellect. (the former tracking the illogical, The pessimist of sensibility the latter the painful. all these standards are only such for moral reasons or, like Plato, ový!” also feared as value-revaluator and seductress A. What is truth? B. Justice. C. On the history of empathy. D. The “good human.” E. The “superior human.” F. The artist. (36) What is truth? (inertia, the hypothesis with which satisfaction emerges, least use of intellectual strength etc.)!”4 2[127]75176 Q) Nihilism is at the door: where does this most uncanny of guests come from? — L 1. Point of departure: it is an error to point to “social distress” or “physiological degenerations” or even to corruption as cause of nihilism. These still permit quite different interpretations. Rather, nihilism lies in a quite specific interpretation: in the Christian-moral(istic). It is the most honest, most empathetic period. Distress, psychic, physical, intellectual distress is in itself not capable in the least of producing nihilism, i.e., the radical rejection of value, meaning, desirability 2. The destruction of Christianity — from its morality (which cannot be superseded —) which turns against the Christian God (the sense of truthfulness, highly developed by Christianity, gets nausea from the falseness and mendaciousness of all Christian interpretation of the world and history. Backlash from “God is the truth” to the fanatical belief “all is false.” Buddhism of deed... [Page 372] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 365 3. Skepticism of morality is decisive. The destruction of the moralistic) interpretation of the world that no longer has any sanction after it tried to flee into a beyond: ends in nihilism, “everything has no meaning” (the unfeasibility of a single interpretation of the world to which tremendous energy has been dedicated — arouses suspicion as to whether al interpretations of the world are not false —) Buddhistic trait, longing for nothingness. (Indian Buddhism does not have a fundamental moral development to it, therefore in its case nihilism is only unconquered morality: existence as

punishment, existence equated with error, hence error as punishment — a moral valuation) The philosophical attempts to overcome the “moral God” (Hegel, pantheism). Overcoming of the populist ideals: the wise man. The saint. The poet. Antagonism of “true” and “beautiful” and “good” — — 4. Against “meaninglessness” on the one hand, against moral value judgments on the other hand: to what extent all science and philosophy so far have stood under moral judgments? and whether we do not incur the hostility of science in the bargain? Or anti-scientism? Critique of Spinozism. Christian value judgments residual everywhere in the socialist and positivist systems. A critique of Christian morality is lacking. 5. the nihilistic consequences of contemporary natural science (alongside its attempts to escape into the beyond). Ultimately a self-disintegration results from its activity, a turning against itse/f an anti-scientism. — Since Copernicus human beings have been rolling out of the center into the x

6. The nihilistic consequences of the political and nationaleconomic way of thinking where all “principles” eventually turn into histrionics: the whiff of mediocrity, wretchedness, insincerity etc. Nationalism, anarchism etc. Punishment. The redeeming class and human being are lacking, the justifier — 7. the nihilistic consequences of history and of the “practical historians” i.e., the romantics. The position of art: absolute [Page 373] 366 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS unoriginality of its position in the modern world. Its dimming. Goethe’s alleged Olympian status. 8. Art and the preparation of nihilism: Romanticism (Wagner’s Nibelungen conclusion.) 2[128]!77178 I. I. Fundamental contradiction in civilization and the elevation of the human being. It is the time of the great noon, of the most terrible brightening: my kind of pessimism: — great point of departure. Moral(istic) valuations as a history of lying and the art of slander in the service of a will to power (of the herd-will) that revolts against the stronger human beings III. The conditions of all elevations of culture (of the enabling of a selection at the expense of a crowd) are the conditions of all growth. IV. The ambiguity of the world as question of strength, which observes all things under the perspective of its growth. The moral Christian value judgments as slave-revolt and slavemendacity (against the aristocratic values of the ancient world) How far does art reach down into the nature of strength? 2[129] 179 The Eternal Recurrence. Zarathustran Dances and Processions. Part One: God’s Death Festival. By Friedrich Nietzsche. 1. God’s death festival. 2. At the great noon. 3. “Where is the hand for this hammer?” 4. We Oath-Takers. [Page 374] 2 AUTUMN I—AUTUMN 1886 367 I. The plague city. He is warned, he is not afraid and goes inside, disguised. All kinds of pessimism parade by. The prophet interprets every parade. The mania for the different, the mania for No, finally the mania for nothingness follow one another. In the end Zarathustra gives the explanation: God is dead, this is the cause of the greatest danger? what? it could also be the cause of the greatest courage! II. The

appearance of the friends. The enjoyment of the perfect by those who are going under: People departing. The accounting of friends. Processions. The decisive time, the great noon. The great gratitude- and death-sacrifice to the dead God. III. The new task. The death of God, for the The means to the task. prophet the most terrible event, The friends abandon him. is the happiest and most hopeful event for Zarathustra. Zarathustra dies. IV. We oath-takers 2[130]!8° The phenomenon “artist” is still the most easily transparent: — from there look to the basic instincts of power, of nature etc.! Also of religion and morality! “play,” the useless, as the ideal of the one who is bristling with strength, as “childish.” The “childishness” of God, nats naitwv'®! 2[131]!82 Plan of the first book. What is dawning is the contrast between the world that we venerate, and the world that we live, that we — are. What remains [Page 375] 368 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS is to do away either with our venerations or with ourselves. The latter is nihilism. Preponderance of the north over the south.'® I. The nihilism that is approaching, theoretical and practical. Erroneous derivation of the same. (Pessimism, its types: preludes of nihilism, even though not necessary.) . Christianity perishing from its morality. “God is truth.” “God is love” “the just God.” — The greatest event — “God is dead” — only dully felt. The German attempt to transform Christianity) into a gnosis has broken out into deepest mistrust: what is “untruthful” in it is perceived most strongly (against Schelling e.g.) . Morality, henceforth without sanction, does not know how to maintain itself anymore. One finally lets the moral interpretation drop — (Emotions everywhere still full of after-notes of the Christian value judgment —) . But value so far rested on moral judgments, above all the value of philosophy! (“of the will to truth” —) the populist ideals “the wise man” “the prophet”!*4 “the saint” have lapsed . Nihilistic trait in the natural sciences. (“meaninglessness” —) Causalism, mechanism. “Conformity to law” an interlude, a residue. . Likewise in politics: what is lacking is belief in one’s rights, innocence, what reigns is telling lies, pandering to the moment . Likewise in the national economy: the abolition of slavery: lack of a redeeming class, of a justifier — Rise of anarchism. “Education?” . Likewise in history: fatalism, Darwinism, thelastattempts to interpolate interpretations of reason and divinity fail. Sentimentality for the past; one should not bear biography! — (phenomenalism here too: character as mask, there are no facts) [Page 376] 2 AUTUMN I— AUTUMN 1886 369 9. Likewise in art: romanticism and its backlash (aversion to romantic ideals and lies) the pure “artists” (indifferent toward content) The latter, moral, as the sense of greater truthfulness, but pessimistic (Father-confessor-psychology and puritan-psychology, two forms of psychological romanticism: but also its backlash, the attempt to position oneself purely artistically in relation to “human beings” — even here the inverse valuation is not yet dared!)*® 10. The entire European system of human striving feels itself

partly “meaningless,” partly “immoral.” Probability of a new Buddhism. The highest danger. “How do truthfulness, love, justice relate to the real world?” Not at all! — The signs European nihilism. Its cause: the devaluation of previous values. The obscure word “pessimism”: people who find themselves to be badly off and people who find themselves to be too well off — both have been p?06

The immutable sequence of certain phenomena does not prove a “law,” but instead a power relationship between 2 or more forces. To say: “but precisely this relationship stays the same!” means nothing other than: “one and the same force cannot also be another force.” —What is at stake is not a succession — but an interpenetration, a process in which the individual successive moments do not condition one another as causes and effects... The separation of the “doing” from the “doer,” the event from a (something) that makes the event, the process from a something that is not process but enduring, substance, thing, body, soul etc. — the attempt to comprehend events as a kind of shifting and place-changing of “what is,” of what remains: this old mythology established the belief in “cause and effect” after it had found a solid form in ling(uistic) grammatical) functions. —?°” a[140]2%8

Against the two claims “the same can only be known by the same” and “the same can only be known by the unsame” — about which already in antiquity there had been a centurieslong battle — today we can object, from the point of view of a more rigorous and more cautious concept of knowing: there can be no knowing at all — and this precisely because the same [Page 381] 374 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS cannot know the same, just as little as the same can be known by the unsame. — 2(141] These divisions of doing and doer, of doing and suffering, of being and becoming, of cause and of effect even the belief in changes posits in advance the belief in something that “is changed.” Reason is the philosophy of appearance 2[142]209-210 (30) the “regularity” of succession is only a symbolic expression, as if here a rule were being followed: no fact. Likewise “conformity to law.” We find a formula in order to express an ever-recurring kind of result: in doing so we have not discovered a “law,” still less a force that is the cause of the recurrence of results. That something always happens thus and (such) is interpreted here as if a being always acted thus and such as a result of obedience to a law or a law giver: whereas, aside from the “law,” it would have the freedom to act differently. But precisely that thus-and-not-otherwise could stem from the being itself, that did not behave thus and such only with regard to a law, but as constituted thus and such. This means only: something cannot also be something else, cannot do now this now that, is neither free nor unfree, but precisely thus and such. The error lies in the fictional insertion of a subject 21143)” Supposing the world possessed a single quantum of force, then it is plain that every power-shift in any place would condition the whole system — therefore along with the causality succeeding one another would be a dependence next to and with one another. [Page 382] 2 AUTUMN

1885—AUTUMN 1886 375 2[144]2!2-213 (40) Supposing even that a counter-proof to the Christian faith could not be produced, Pascal considered it prudent in the highest sense to be a Christian given the fearful possibility that it could nevertheless be true. Today as a sign of how much Christianity has lost in terms of fearfulness, one finds those othe(r) attempts at its justification, namely that even if it were an error one would still have the great advantage and pleasure of this error one's whole life long: it seems therefore that this faith should be maintained precisely for the sake of its calming effects — hence not out of fear of a threatening possibility, but rather out of fear of a life that loses its charm. This hedonistic turn, proof derived from pleasure, is a symptom of decline: it replaces proof derived from strength, from that which is devastating in the Christian idea, from fear. In fact in this reinterpretation Christianity approaches exhaustion: one makes do with an opiate Christianity, because one has neither the strength to want to search, to fight, to dare, to stand alone nor for Pascalism, for dee(p) brooding self-contempt, for faith in human unworthiness, for the anxiety of the “possibly-damned.” But a Christianity that above all is supposed to calm sick nerves has no need at all of that fearful solution of a “God on the cross”: which is why everywhere in Europe Buddhism is silently making progress. 2[145]?”4 The interpretation of an event as either doing or suffering — therefore every doing a suffering — says: every single change, a becoming different presupposes an author and someone on whom “change” is made. 2[146] A perfect analogy can be drawn between the simplifying and compressing of countless experiences to general principles [Page 383] 376 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS and the becoming of the sperm cell that bears within it the entire abbreviated past: and likewise in the artistic forming from fertile basic thoughts up to a “system” and the becoming of an organism as a thinking-out and thinking-forth, as a remembering-back of an entire previous life, of realizing-back, incorporation. In brief: visible organic life and invisible creative psychic controlling and thinking contain a parallelism: in the “artwork” one can demonstrate these two sides most clearly as parallel. — The extent to which thinking, inferring and everything logical can be seen as exterior: as symptom of much more inward and more basic events? 2[147]215216 (30) “end” and “means” as interpretation { (wot as facts) “cause and effect” as interpretation 4 all in the sense of a “subject and object” as interpretation | will to power “doing and suffering” (“thing in itself” and “appearance”) as interpretation and to what extent perhaps necessary interpretations? (as “preserving”) 2i 48)?!” The will to power interprets. in the formation of an organ interpretation is at stake; it demarcates, determines degrees, power differentials. Mere power differentials could not perceive themselves as such: a growth-willing something must be there, that interprets every other growth-willing something in terms of its value. Jn this similar — — In truth interpretation is a means itself of becoming master

over something. (The organic process presupposes constant interpreting. 2[149]718 A “thing in itself” just as wrong as a “meaning in itself,” “a significance in itself.” There are no “facts in themselves,” rather a meaning must always be inserted first, so that there can be “ facts” [Page 384] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 377 The “what is that?” is a positing-of-meaning from the point of view of something else. “Essence,” “essentiality” is something perspectival and already presupposes a multiplicity. What underlies here is always “what is that for me?” (for us, for everything that lives etc.) A thing would be described only when all beings had asked and received an answer to their “what is that?” about it. Suppose a single being with its own relations and perspectives to all things were missing: and the thing would still not be “defined.” 2[150]?” In brief, the essence of a thing is also only an opinion of the “thing.” Or rather: the concept “that counts as” is the real “that is,” the only “that is.” 21512 One is not allowed to ask “then who is interpreting?” rather interpretation itself, as a form of the will to power, has existence (but not as a “being,” but instead as a process, a becoming) as an affect. 2i 52]°7! The emergence of “things” is entirely the work of the representing, thinking, willing, inventing ones. The concept “thing” itself just as well as all properties. — Even “the subject” is such a creation, a “thing,” like all others: a simplification in order to describe the force that posits, invents, thinks as such, in contrast to all individual positing, inventing, thinking itself. Therefore the capacity described in contrast to all that is individual: at bottom activity summarized with respect to all expected activity (activity and the probability of similar activity) 2153]??? NB. From the world known to us the humanitarian God cannot be proven: today you can be compelled and driven this far — but what conclusion do you draw from this? Either he is [Page 385] 378 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS not provable to us: skepticism of knowledge. But all of you fear the conclusion: “from the world known to us an entirely different god would be provable, one who at least is not humanitarian” — — and, that means, i.e., you hold on tightly to your God and invent for him a world that is not known to us. 211541” (36) Against the scientific prejudice. — The greatest fable is the one about knowledge. One wants to know how the things in themselves are constituted: but behold, there are no things in themselves! But supposing even that there were an in-itself, an unconditioned, then precisely for that reason it could not be known! Something unconditioned cannot be known: otherwise it would precisely not be unconditioned! But knowing is always “positing-oneself-in-conditionto-something” — — ; such a “knowing one” desires that what he wants to know does not concern him; and that this same thing should not concern anyone at all; whereby first a contradiction occurs, in wanting-to-know and in the demand that it should not concern him (why then know at all!) and second, because something that does not concern anyone does not at all exist, therefore also

cannot be known. — Knowing means “to posit oneself in condition to something”: to feel oneself conditioned by something and between us — — it is therefore in any case a determining describing making conscious of conditions (not a fathoming of essences, things, “in-themselves”) ?*4 aftss]225226 Deep aversion to resting once and for all in some overall-view of the world; magic of the opposing ways of thinking; not letting oneself be deprived of the charm of the enigmatic character. [Page 386] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 379 2[156] For the chapter “artists” (as molders, value-assigners, appropriators) Our languages as after-notes of the oldest appropriations of things, by rulers and thinkers alike — — : running alongside every coined word was the command “thus shall the thing be named from now on!” 21577 Shouldn’t all quantities be signs of qualities? The greater power corresponds to a different consciousness, feeling, desire, to a different perspectival gaze; growth itself is a desire to be more; out of a quale??? grows a desire for a more of quantum; in a purely quantitative world everything would be dead, rigid, unmoved. — The reduction of all qualities to quantities is nonsense: what results is that one and the other stand together, an analogy — 2[158]2? Psychological history of the concept “subject.” The body, the thing, the “whole” constructed by the eye trigger the differentiation of a doing from a doer; the doer, the cause of the doing, ever more subtly comprehended, in the end left the “subject” behind. 2[159]?° Has a force ever been demonstrated? No, instead effects, translated into a completely foreign language. But the regularity of succession has spoiled us so much that we are not surprised by its oddness?>! 2[160] Today, when what matters is to give this book, which lies open, but nevertheless demands its key, an entrance a preface, it should be the first to say why I feared a preface back then. [Page 387] 380 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 2[161]222233 (41) For the Preface. Deeply mistrustful of epistemological dogmas, (I) loved to look out of now this, now that window, I was wary of committing (myself) to them, regarded them as harmful — and ultimately: is it probable that a tool can criticize its own suitability?? — What I paid attention to instead was that never has an epistemological skepticism or dogma arisen without ulterior motives — that it has a second rank value as soon as one considers what at bottom forced one to this position: even the very will to certainty, when it is not the will “I only want to live” — — — Basic insight: Kant as well as Hegel as well as Schopenhauer — the skeptical-epochal position as well as the historical and the pessimistic are of moral origin. I saw no one who would have dared a critique of moral value feelings: and I soon turned my back on the meager attempts to arrive at a history of the emergence of these feelings (as among the English and German Darwinists). — How does one explain Spinoza’s position, his renunciation and rejection of moral value judgments? (Was it one consequence of a theodicy?) 2[162]?34 One notices in my earlier writings a good will to unlocked horizons, a certain prudent caution

before convictions, a mistrust of the enchantments and dupings of conscience that accompany every strong belief; one might see in this in part the wariness of the burned child, of the deceived idealist — more essential to me seems the Epicurean instinct (of a friend of riddles —) who does not want to permit himself to take cheaply the enigmatic character of things, most essential finally an aesthetic aversion toward the big virtuous unconditional words, a taste that defends itself against all quadrangular opposites, desires a good portion of uncertainty in things and takes away the opposites: — as a friend of intermediary colors, shadows, afternoon lights and infinite seas. [Page 388] 2 AUTUMN 1885 —AUTUMN 1886 381 2[163] Customary errors of moral-historians: 1. they show that among different peoples there are different moral valuations and conclude from this that they are nonbinding generally. — Or they assert some arbitrary consensus of peoples, at least of the civilized, in certain matters of morality and conclude from it that it is binding for us! Both are equally naive. 2. they criticize the opinions of a people concerning its morality (concerning the morality's descent, sanction, reasonableness etc.) and believe they have criticized a morality itself, which has been overgrown with the weeds of this unreason. 3. they themselves stand under the rule of a morality without knowing it and at bottom do nothing more than assure the triumph of their belief in it — their grounds only prove their own will that this and that be believed, that this and that should be absolutely true. There isn't much to the moral-historians so far: they themselves usually stand under the command of a morality and at bottom do nothing more than generate its propaganda. Their usual error is that they criticize the foolish opinions of a people concerning its morality (also concerning its descent, sanction, reasonableness) and believe that precisely in doing so they have criticized the morality itself, which has been overgrown with the weeds of this unreason. But the value of a rule "thou shalt" is independent of the opinion people have of it, just as certainly as the value of a medication is independent of whether I think scientifically or like an old woman about medicine Or on the other hand they assert some arbitrary consensus of peoples, at least of the tamed peoples concerning certain matters of morality and conclude from this its absolute binding nature, even for you and me: which are both equally big naivetés — [Page 389] 382 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 2[164]?35 A spirit strengthened by wars and victories, for whom conquest, adventure, danger, pain have even become a requirement; a habit of sharp high air, of winter wanderings, of ice and mountains in every sense; a kind of sublime malice and final mischief of revenge, for there is revenge in it, revenge on life itself when someone who suffers greatly takes life under his protection. This book, which might need not only one preface, is difficult to understand for many reasons, not due to a lack of skill of its author, even less due to his bad will, but (due to) the final mischief of someone who suffers greatly, who constantly makes fun of an ideal believed in

by the people, whom he perhaps has reached in this condition. — And perhaps I have a right to have my say about these conditions, because I have not merely watched them. I have no doubt: at that time what I lived beyond, with an ironic self-superiority, was the condition of the wise man as the people imagine him: the gentle infertility and self-satisfaction of the wise man as the people imagine him, the remoteness and beyond of the “pure-knowing one,” the whole sublime onanism of a spirit who has lost the good will to deeds, to begetting, to creating in every sense. Who shares with me in feeling the wondrous happiness of that period in which this book emerged! The sublime malice of a soul who — — — My taste of today takes pleasure in something else: the human being of great love and of great contempt, who is driven out of all “remoteness” and “beyond” straight into the world by his overflowing strength, who is forced by solitude to create beings for himself who are like him — a human being with the will to a terrible responsibility, forged to his problem What is perhaps most difficult to understand in this difficult to understand book, which needs not only one preface, is the irony of the contrast between its theme, a disintegration and unwinding of moral values — and its tone, that of the highest [Page 39] 32 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS 34 [111] 4 The Germans should cultivate a ruling caste: I confess that there are qualities inherent in Jews that are indispensable to their serving as an ingredient in a race that is supposed to practice world politics. The sense for money has to be learned, inherited and inherited a thousand fold: even now the Jew is a match for the American. 34[112] I point out something new: certainly for such a democratic nature there is the danger of barbarians, but one sees them only in the depths. There is also a different kind of barbarian, they come from the heights: a kind of conquering and ruling nature that looks for a material that they can shape. Prometheus was such a barbarian. — 34[113] Not a people of “professional politicians,” of newspaper readers! 34[114]*° — — — The smallness and pitifulness of the German soul was and is not at all a result of a plurality of small states: it is well known that people in much smaller states have been proud and selfaggrandizing and it is not large states in themselves that make the soul more free and manly. When the slavish imperative “you should and must kneel!” commands in someone’s soul an involuntary bowing of the neck before honorary titles, medals, favorable glances from the top down, in an “empire” he will only bow deeper and lick the dust before his great sovereign more fervently than he did before the smaller one: there is no doubting this. — It can still be seen today in the lower classes of the Italians that aristocratic self-confidence and manly discipline and certainty of themselves belongs to the longest history of their city and has been modeled best for them; a poor gondolier in Venice is still a better figure than a real privy councilor in Berlin, and ultimately even a better man: this is palpable. Just ask the women about it. [Page 390] 2 AUTUMN I—AUTUMN 1886 383 mildest

wisest serenity, in which the greatly suffering one, the one who turns away from life delights as in his final mischief. 2[165]*3° (41) For the Preface of “Dawn” An attempt to think about morality without standing under its spell, mistrustful of being duped by its beautiful gestures and glances A world that we can revere, that corresponds to our worshipping drive — that continuously proves itself — through guidance of the particular and the universal — : this the Christian viewpoint from which we all stem. Through a growth in acuity, mistrust, scientism (also through a more highly cultivated instinct of truthfulness, therefore again under Christian influences) this interpretation has become increasingly disallowed to us. Most subtle way out: Kantian criticism. The intellect disputed its own right to interpretation in this sense as well as to rejection of interpretation in this sense. One satisfied oneself with filling the gap with a more of trust and faith, with a sacrificing of all verifiability of one’s faith, with an incomprehensible and superior “ideal” (God). The Hegelian way out, following Plato, a piece of Romanticism and reaction, simultaneously the symptom of the historical sense, of a new force: the “spirit” itself is the self-disclosing and self-realizing ideal, in “process,” in “becoming” an ever more of this ideal reveals itself; in which we believe — therefore the ideal realizes itself, faith directs itself toward the future, in which it can worship according to its noble requirements. In brief, 1) God is unknowable and unverifiable to us — deeper meaning of the epistemological movement 2) God is verifiable, but as something becoming, and we belong to it, precisely with our push for what is ideal — deeper meaning of the historicizing movement [Page 391] 384

UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS But the same historical sense, transferring over to natural history, has — — — It is obvious: the critique is never shifted to the ideal itself, but only to the problem where its opposition comes from, why it has not yet been reached or why it is not verifiable in matters small and great. The ideal of the wise man to what extent fundamentally moralistic so far? — — — It makes the biggest difference: whether one feels this distress as distress as a result of passion, as a result of craving or whether one barely reaches it as problem using the pinnacle of thought and a certain strength of historical imagination . . . Apart from religious-philosophical observation we find the same phenomenon: utilitarianism (socialism, democratism) criticizes the descent of moral valuations, but it believes in them, just like the Christian. (Naïveté, as if morality would remain if the sanctioning God were missing. The “beyond” absolutely essential if the belief in morality is to be maintained.) Basic problem: where does this omnipotence of faith come from? Of faith in morality? (— which also betrays itself in the fact that even the basic conditions of life are falsely interpreted in favor of morality: despite knowledge of the animal world and the plant world. “self-preservation,” Darwinistic perspective on reconciliation of altruistic and egoistic principles.?°” (critique of egoism, e.g., Laroche-foucauld) My attempt to

understand moral judgments as symptoms and sign languages in which processes of physiological flourishing or failing, likewise the consciousness of preservation- and growth-conditions are betrayed: a manner of interpretation with the value of astrology. Prejudices prompted by instincts (of races, communities, of different stages like youth or dotage etc.) Applied to the specifically Christian-European morality: our moral judgments are signs of decline, of unbelief in /ifé, a preparation of pessimism. [Page 392] 2 AUTUMN I —AUTUMN 1886 385 What does it mean that we have interpreted a contradiction into existence? — Decisive importance: behind all other valuations those moral valuations stand commanding. Supposing they fall away, by what do we measure then? And then what is the value of knowledge etc. etc.??? My main pro position: there are no moral phenomena, but only a moralistic) interpretation of these phenomena. This interpretation itself is of extra-moral origin.)*8 2[166]?39 Preface to the “Joyful Science” A diversion before a great undertaking for which one now finally feels strength returning to himself: as Buddha devoted himself for 10 days to world(ly) pleasures when he had found his main proposition. General mockery of all moralizing of today. Preparation for Zarathustra’s naive-ironic position on all holy things (naive form of superiority: playing with the holy) (42) Concerning the misunderstanding of “cheerfulness.” Temporary redemption from protracted tension, the exuberance, the saturnalia of a spirit who consecrates and prepares himself for protracted and terrible resolutions. The “fool” in the form of “science,” This book requires perhaps not only one preface: people have understood nothing at all about its “joyful science.” Even about the title — — — People have understood nothing at all about this “joyful science”; not even its title, about whose Provençal meaning at least many scholars — — — The triumphant condition from which this book emerged is hard to comprehend — but I myself had emerged from a condition. [Page 393] 386 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS the consciousness of aversion to everything that lay behind me, paired with a sublime will to gratitude even for my “behind me,” which was not too distant from the feeling of the right to a long revenge a piece of gray ice-cold senility switched on at the most unjust point of life, the tyranny of pain outdone by the tyranny of pride that rejects the consequences of pain, solitude as self-defense against a pathologically clairvoyant misanthropy and therefore still loved and enjoyed as redemption, on the other hand a longing for what is most bitter sour and harmful in knowledge It belongs to the things that I will not forget that people congratulated me on this book more honestly than on any other, they even let me know how healthy such a way of thinking was Nothing offends as deeply as letting people notice the height and severity of one’s own demands on oneself. Nothing offends as deeply, nothing sets people apart so thoroughly as letting people notice something of the height a(nd) severity with which one treats oneself: oh how accommodating and

lovely everyone shows themselves to be toward us as soon as we do as everyone does and “let ourselves go” as everyone does! It belongs to the things that I will not forget that people expressed more congratulations to me for this book of the “gai saber” than for all the others put together: suddenly they were reconciled with me, they showed themselves to be accommodating and lovely once more, everyone saw in it a recovery, return, homecoming, soul-searching — namely as a return to “everyone.” Aside from a few scholars whose vanity took offense at the word “science” (— they let me know, Perhaps this is “joyful” [Page 394] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 387 but certainly not “science” —) everyone took this book as a return to “everyone” and for its sake showed themselves to be accommodating and lovely toward me: and I figured out after the fact how nothing offends most deeply, and most thoroughly against us — — — NB Perhaps we could also lend an ear in conclusion to a few exuberant songs in which a poet makes fun of the poets and their beautiful lyrical feelings. NB!! Zarathustra, who in a holy manner counters all holy things with courage and mockery and goes his way with innocence to the most forbidden, evil things — — — 2[167] Denial of causality. In order not to make everything responsible for anything and to hold short the thread on which something hangs. “Chance” really exists. 2[168]24] Tendency of moral evolution. Everyone desires that no other theory and estimation of things should gain validity except for the one from which he himself benefits. Basic tendency consequently of the weak and the mediocre of all times to make the strong weaker, to pull them down: chief means the moral judgment. The behavior of the stronger toward the weaker is stigmatized; the higher conditions of the strong get bad labels. The struggle of the many against the few, of the ordinary against the rare, of the weak against the strong — one of its most subtle interruptions is that the chosen refined more demanding presented themselves as the weak and rejected the cruder means of power — 2[169]?42243 (34) It could appear as if I had evaded the question of certainty. The opposite is true: but while I asked about the criterion of [Page 395] 388 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS certainty I tested to determine in the first place according to which scales things have been weighed so far — and whether the question of certainty itself were not already a dependent question, a question of the second rank. 2[170]244245 (44) What is lacking is the knowledge and consciousness of which turn-arounds moral judgment has already gone through, and how actually several times already in the most fundamental sense “evil” has been rebaptized “good.” To one of these shifts I have with the antithesis “morality of customs” and — — — Conscience has also switched spheres: there used to be a sting of conscience of the herd To what extent even our conscience, with its apparent personal responsibility is in fact still herd-conscience. 2[171]46 (43) The sting of conscience like all resentments is missing in a great fullness of strength. (Mirabeau, B. Cellini, Cardanus). 2[172]24” “Being” — we have no

other idea of it than “living? — Therefore how can something dead “be”? 20173] On Zart pour l'art cf. Doudan Pensées? p. 10 how the cult of colors depraves Scherer VIII?” p. 292. 21174] One rediscovers in things nothing other than what one previously oneself put into them: this childish game, of which I do not wish to think poorly, calls itself “science”? On the [Page 396] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 389 contrary: let us continue with both, both require our good cheer — some of us to rediscover, the others — we others! — to put things in! — ultimately a human being rediscovers in things nothing other than what he himself put into them: rediscovery calls itself science, putting things in — art, religion, love, pride. In both, even if they should be childish games, — — — a [r]251-252.253 (45) NB. Against the theory of the influence of milieu and of external causes: the inner force is infinitely superior; much that looks like influence from without is only its adaptation from the inside out. The very same milieu's can be oppositely interpreted and exploited: there are no facts. — A genius is not explained from such conditions of origin — 2[176] What constitutes the strong human being of the 20th century: — 2177] (46) Populist ideals e.g., Francis of Assisi: denial of the soul hierarchy, before God all equal. 2[178]255 It does good to take “right” and “wrong” etc. in a certain narrow bourgeois sense, like “do right and fear no one”: i.e., to do one's duty according to a certain crude scheme within which a community exists. 2117916 Preface Proceeding from an idea of life (that is not a wanting-to-preserve-oneself but a wanting-to-grow) I took a glance at the [Page 397] 390 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS basic instinct of our political intellectual social movement of Europe. On what have I possibly contributed ideas? 1) that behind the most fundamental differences of philosophies stands a certain equality of confession: the unconscious guidance by moral ulterior intentions, better: by popular ideals; — that consequently the moral problem is more radical than the epistemological 2) that at some time a reversed look is necessary in order to bring into the light the prejudice of morality and of all popular ideals: for which every kind of “free spirit” — i.e., immoral ones — can be used. 3) that Christianity, as a plebian ideal, aims with its morality at damaging the stronger more highly constituted manly types and favors a herdlike human being: that its morality is a precursor of the democratic way of thinking 4) that science goes forward in league with the equality movement, is democracy, that all virtues of the scholar reject order of rank 5) that democratic Europe is heading only for a sublime cultivation of slavery, that must be commanded by a strong race in order to tolerate itself 6) that an aristocracy only emerges under harsh prolonged pressure (mastery over the earth) 2[180]?” Perhaps there are a couple of human beings in Europe, even in Germany, who are able to reach the problem of this book, and not only with their curiosity, not only with the feelers of a pampered intellect, of their divining power of imagination and imitation, even of their “historical sense,” but instead

with the passion of the abstinent: whose soul has enough elevation to understand my conception of the “free spirit” as a means of expression, as a subtlety, if you will, as a modesty: they will not complain about my obscurity. [Page 398] 2
 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 391 There are many things against which I have not found it necessary to speak out: it goes without saying that the “literary man” is repugnant to me, that all political parties of today are repugnant to me, that a socialist is treated not only with pity by me. The two noblest forms of human being whom I encountered in the flesh (were) the perfect Christian — I count it an honor to stem from a family that took its Christianity seriously in every sense — and the perfect artist of the romantic ideal, which I found to be deep below the Christian level: it is plain as day that when one has turned his back on these forms, because they do not satisfy, then one does not easily find satisfaction in another kind of human being of today — to this extent I am condemned to solitude, even though I can very well imagine a kind of human being in whom I would have pleasure. My patient and lenient disgust with the self-sufficiency of our metropolises, which adorn themselves with culture, of our scholars — — — 2[181]258 (42) The irony of Plato, with which an overly large tenderness of feelings and of the senses, a vulnerability of the heart knew how to protect itself, at least to conceal itself, that Olympian nature of Goethe, who composed verses about his sufferings in order to be rid of them, likewise Stendhal, Mérimée?5? — 2[182]260.261 (10) In order for something to last that is longer than the individual, therefore in order for a work to last that perhaps an individual has created: for this all possible kinds of limitation, of onesidedness etc. must be imposed on the individual. By what means? Love honor gratitude toward the person who created the work are a help: or that our forefathers fought for it: or that my descendants are only guaranteed if I guarantee that work (e.g., the mOAtc?“”). Morality is essentially the means [Page 399] 392
 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS to bring something to duration over and beyond individuals, or rather by an enslavement of individuals. It is self-evident that the perspective from below to above will yield entirely different expressions than the one from above to below. A power-complex: how is it preserved? By the fact that many generations sacrifice themselves to it, i.e., — — — 2[183]° For the
 Introduction For anyone who has lived together with a big question mark as if with his destiny and whose days and nights were consumed by purely solitary dialogues and decisions, the opinions of strangers about the same problem are a kind of noise against which he defends himself and covers his ears: moreover, something obtrusive inappropriate and shameless so to speak, on the part of those who, as he believes, have no right to such a problem: because they did not find it. They are the hours of mistrust toward himself, of mistrust toward his own right and prerogative where the hermit-like loving one — for that is a philosopher — demands to hear everything that is said and not said about his problem; perhaps

in doing so he divines that the world is full of jealous loving ones like him, and that everything loud, clamorous, public, the whole foreground of politics, routine, annual fair, “time” seems to be invented only so that everything that is hermit and philosopher in us today can hide behind it — as in its ownmost solitude; all occupied with one thing, in love with one thing, jealous of one thing, precisely of Ais problem. “There is nothing else at all being thought today where thinking even gets done” — he finally says to himself; “everything turns on this question mark; what seemed reserved for me is being wooed by the entire age: at bottom nothing else is happening at all; I myself — but what do I matter!” [Page 4] viii CONTENTS Prefatory Note by Mazzino Montinari to KSA Volume 12 258 Notebook 1 = N VII 2b. Autumn 1885—Spring 1886 261 Notebook 2 = W I 8. Autumn 1885—Autumn 1886 312 Notebook 3 = W I 7b. W 13b. Mp XVI 2b. Mp XVI ib. Beginning 1886—Spring 1886 403 Notebook 4 = D 18. Mp XV 2c. Mp XVII 3a. Mp XVI 1b. Beginning 1886—Spring 1886 408 Reference Matter NOTES 47 COLLI AFTERWORD 465 TRANSLATOR’S AFTERWORD 473 INDEX OF PERSONS 529 SUBJECT INDEX 545 [Page 40] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 33 34[115]*” The Servant’s Soul. The Corruption of the Blood. Moral Tartuffery. The “Mind.”°8 Lack of Clarity The Vacillators. Conjecture on the Southern Lands. Ugliness The Hinter-Soul. The Dependence on France. The German Professor and the Officer. The *niaiserie allemande*.®° The German Writing Style. The Hermit. The “Eternal Feminine” in the German Man. Intoxication and Music. The “Historical Sense.” The Actor. Convenience (Philistines) and War. The Philosophers. Pessimism. (Comparison with France). More herd animal than ever — but there are favorable conditions for individuals as well. 34 [116] What is most admirable about Kant is that he got over his Leibnizian seduction and retained the best of the previous century, sensualism.*° 34[117] NB. Schopenhauer, in his youth seduced by the romantics and diverted from his best instincts, was at bottom a Voltairean in body and soul, and really a child of the previous century — for the rest however led beyond French taste by the Greeks and by Goethe —and above all — not a theologian! The “immutability [Page 400] 2 AUTUMN 1885—AUTUMN 1886 393 2[18 42% (47) I come late to the awareness of how far moralistic skepticism has gone: how do I recognize myself? Determinism: we are not responsible for our natures Phenomenalism: we know nothing about a “thing in itself” My problem: What damage so far has humankind had from morals as well as from its morality? Damage to the spirit etc.? my disgust with the wise man as a spectator my higher concept “artist” 2[185]?°° (47) “We Immoralists” real critique of the moral ideal — of the good human being, of the saint, of the wise man — of the slandering of so-called evil properties — what meaning do the different moral interpretations have? — what is the danger of the interpretation that is dominant in Europe now? — what is the standard according to which measuring can be done? (“will to

power”) 2[186] Do not believe that I will challenge you to the same risk! Or even to the same solitude. For whoever goes his own way encounters no one: “one’s own ways” are like that. No one comes to “help” him in this, and he must deal himself with everything that buffets him by way of danger, chance, malice and bad weather. He happens to have his way for himself, and also his occasional annoyance with his harsh inexorable “for himself”: to which it belongs for instance that even his good friends do not always see and know where he really goes, [Page 401] 394 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS where he really wants to go — and at times ask themselves: what? is he going at all? does he have — a way? ... — Insofar as I am here making an attempt to give a hint about the way I have come to those who so far have remained sympathetic to me — despite everything — it behooves me to reveal first the paths on which people have occasionally searched and even believed to have found me. People have a tendency to mistake me: I admit it; likewise that it would be of great service to me if someone else were to defend and define me against these mistakings. But, as I said, I must come to my own aid: why does one go “one’s own way”? antimetaphysical, antiromantic, artistic, pessimistic, skeptical, historical An artistic world view an antimetaphysical — yes, but an artistic one —?° a pessimistic-Buddhistic — a skeptical — a scientific — not posit(istic) 2[187] — placatumque nitet diffuso lumine coelum?® — 2[188]° that the history (of) all ph(enomena) of morality could be simplified to the extent that Schopenhauer believed — namely such that compassion is to be discovered as the root of every moral(alistic) impulse so far — this degree of absurdity and naiveté could be achieved only by a thinker who was bereft of all historical instinct and had eluded in the most astonishing manner even that strong schooling in history that the Germans from Herder to Hegel had undergone. 2[189]?°° The inquiry into the descent of our valuations and tablets of good does not in the least coincide with their criticism, as is so [Page 402] 2 AUTUMN I—AUTUMN 1886 395 often believed: even though the insight into some pudenda origo?” brings with it for our emotions a decline in value of whatever thing originated thus and prepares a critical mood and attitude toward the same. 2[190]272273 (47) what are our valuations and even our moral tablets worth? What comes out of their rule? For whom? With respect to what? — Answer: for life. But what is life? Here then a new more definite version of the concept “life” is needed: my formula for it is: life is will to power. what does valuating mean in itself? does it point back or down to another metaphysical world? As Kant still believed (who is prior to the great historical movement) In sum: where did it emerge? Or did it not “emerge”? Answer: moral valuating is an interpretation,’ a way of interpreting.” The interpretation itself is a symptom of certain physiological conditions, likewise of a certain spiritual level of ruling judgments. Who interprets? — Our affects. 2[191] My assertion: that one must subject moral

valuations themselves to a critique. That one must call a halt to the moral emotional impulse with the question: why? That this demand for a “Why?”, for a critique or morals, is precisely our current form of morality itself, as a sublime sense of honesty. That our honesty, our will not to deceive ourselves must prove itself: “why not?” — In what forum? The will not (to) allow oneself to be deceived is of different origin, a caution against being overpowered, exploitation, a self-defense instinct of life. These are my demands of you — they may sound harsh enough to your ears —: that you should subject moral valuations themselves to a critique. That you should call a halt to the moral emotional impulse that here demands submission [Page 403] 396 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS and zot criticism with the question: “why submission?” That you should regard this demand for a “Why?”, for a critique of morality, precisely as your current form of morality itself, as the most sublime kind of righteousness, which does honor to you and your age.””° 2[192] the feeling: thou shalt!, one’s disquiet in being violated — question: “who is giving orders here? Whose disfavor do we fear here?” 2[193]277278 (7) Our bad habit of taking a mnemonic device, an abbreviating formula as essence, finally as cause e.g., to say of lightning: “it flashes.” Or even the little word “I.” To posit a kind of perspective in seeing again as the cause of seeing itself: that was the trick in the invention of the ‘subject,’ of the “I”! 2[194]272280 Stendhal: “Combien de lieues ne ferais-je pas a pied, et a combien de jours de prison ne me soumettrais-je pas pour entendre Don Juan ou le Matrimonio segreto: et je ne sais pour quelle autre chose je ferais cet effort??? At the time he was 56 years old. 2[195]282283 (41) Hegel: his popular side the theory of war and of great men. Right is with the victor: he represents the progress of humankind. Attempt to prove the rule of morality using history. Kant: detached from us, invisible, real, a realm of moral values Hegel: a verifiable development, the becoming-visible of the moral realm [Page 404] 2 AUTUMN I—AUTUMN 1886 397 We do not want to be deceived either in the Kantian or the Hegelian manner: — we no longer believe, like them, in morality, and consequently nor do we have any philosophies to found so that morality remains justified. Criticism as well as historicism do not have their charm for us in this — well, what charm then do they have? 2[196] We homeless ones — yes! But we want to exploit the advantages of our situation and, far from perishing of it, let ourselves benefit from the open air and powerful fullness of light. 2[197] Nonbelievers and godless ones, yes! — but without that bitterness and passion of one who tears himself away and fabricates a faith, a purpose, often a martyrdom from his non-faith: we have simmered and grown cold in the realization that in the world things are absolutely not divine, indeed they are not even compatible with a rational, merciful, humane standard; we know it, the world in which we live is immoral, undivine, inhuman — for far too long we have interpreted it in the sense of our reverence. The world is not worth that

which we have believed: and the last thread of solace that was spun by Schopenhauer we have ourselves torn: that precisely this is the meaning of the whole of history, that it figures out its own meaninglessness and grows sick of itself. This growing-sick-of-existence, this will to no-longer-willing, this shattering of our personal will, our personal well-being, self (lessness) (as an expression of this inverted willing) — this and nothing else Schopenhauer wanted to see honored with the higher honors: he called it morality, he decreed that all selfless action — — — he believed he ensured the value even of art by interpreting the indifferent states that it creates as preparations for that total detachment and satiety of disgust. — but would we really be pessimists with respect to the sight of an immoral world? No, because we do not believe in [Page 405] 398 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS morality — — we believe that mercy, right, compassion a(nd) lawfulness are by far overvalued, that their opposite has been slandered, that in both, in exaggeration and slander, in the entire application of the moralistic ideal and standard there has been a tremendous danger for humans. Nor should we forget the good byproduct: the refinement?^{*4} of interpretation, of moral(istic) vivisection, the sting of conscience has elevated the Jalseness of humans in the extreme and made them intelligent. In itself a religion has nothing to do with morality: but the two descendants of the Jewish religion) are both essentially moral religions, those that issue precepts about how people should live and create an audience for their demands by means of reward and punishments.⁷° 2[198] the era of Bismarck (the era of German dumbing-down) in such swampy terrain thrive, as is only fair, also the genuine swamp plants, e.g., the a(nty-Semite) 2[199] — to be nationalistic in the sense and to the degree that is now demanded by public opinion, would seem to me, to us more spiritual humans, to be not only a matter of bad taste: but a dishonesty, an arbitrary anesthetizing of our better science and conscience 2[200] Likewise we are no longer Christians: we have grown apart from Christianity, not because we lived too distant from it, but because we lived too close to it, even more because we grew out of it — it is our stricter and more pampered piety itself that forbids us today from still being Christians — 2[201] When I once wrote the word “unfashionable” on my books, how much youth, inexperience, isolation expresses itself in this [Page 406] 2 AUTUMN I—AUTUMN 1886 399 word! Today I comprehend that with this kind of lament enthusiasm and dissatisfaction I actually belonged to the most modern of moderns. 2[202]?°° Kant: the mere idea of a possible science that one seeks to nourish in many different ways, up to the point where the single footpath, quite overgrown with sensuality, is removed” — 2[203]287 And even today the philosophers unknowingly give the strongest evidence for how far this authority of morality reaches. With all their will to independence, with their habits or principles of doubt, even with their vice of contradiction, of innovation at any cost, of haughtiness of every height — what

becomes of them as soon as they reflect on “thou shalt” and “thou shalt not”? Immediately there is nothing more modest on earth: the Circe morality just breathed on them and enchanted them! All these proud and solitary wanderers! — Now all at once they are lambs, now they want to be the herd. At first the whole lot of them wants to have their “thou shalt” and “thou shalt not” in common with everyone — first sign of abandoned independence. And what is their criterion of a moral precept? They are all of one mind: their universal validity, their focus away from the person. This I call “herd.” Thereupon, of course, they part ways: for each one wants to be of service to m(orality) with its best energy. Most of them resort to “grounding morality,” as they say, namely wedding and uniting it to reason, if possible to the point of unity; the more subtle ones on the contrary find the token and prerogative of their rank, their rank that is superior to reason, in the ungroundability of morality; others will want to deduce it historically (perhaps with the Darwinists, who invented the home remedy for bad historians, “first utility and compulsion, then habit, finally instinct, even pleasure”), still others refute these deductions and deny in general any historical deductability of [Page 407] 400 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS morality, and this likewise to the honor of their rank, their high species and calling: but all are of one mind in the main thing “morality is here, morality is given!”, they all believe, honestly, unconsciously, unflinchingly in the value of that which they call morality, that is, they stand under its authority. Yes! The value of morality! Is it permissible that here someone speaks up who has doubts about precisely this value? And is also concerned only in this respect about its deduction, deductability, psychological possibility and impossibility? 2[204]?88 Book Five. We Contrarians. Our new “freedom” Against the popular ideal human beings How far do art and falsity go into the essence of being? Why we are no longer Christians. Why we are antinationalistic. Pessimism and Dionysianism. Our mistrust of logic Lart pour l'art? The limitedness of all teleology. Against the causality-fatalism. Against the theory of milieu: mask and character. On the concept “phenomenalism.” Against romanticism. Concept of slavery i.e., of making into tools Misunderstanding of cheerfulness.” What the order of rank does. Critique of modern philosophy: erroneous point of departure, as if “facts of consciousness” existed — and no phenomenalism in introspection”! 2[205]?2 There is no egoism at all that stays within itself and does not overreach — consequently that “permissible,” “morally indifferent” e(goism) of which you speak does not exist at all. [Page 408] 2 AUTUMN I—AUTUMN 1886 401 One promotes ones ego constantly at “the expense of another”; life always lives at the expense of other life. — Whoever does not comprehend this has not yet taken the first personal step toward honesty. 2[206]2932% (48) What a feeling of freedom there is in perceiving as we freed spirits perceive, that we are not harnessed into a system of “purposes”! Likewise that the concepts “reward” and “punishment”

do not reside in the essence of existence! Likewise, that the good and the evil deed are called good and evil not in themselves, but only under the perspective of the preservation tendencies of certain kinds of human communities! Likewise that our accounts of pleasure and pain have no cosmic, let alone a metaphysical meaning! — That pessimism that opts to put the pleasure and displeasure of existence itself on the scales, with its arbitrary imprisonment in the pre-Copernican prison and field of vision, would (be) something backwards and back-sliding, if it were not merely a bad joke of a Berliner (the pessimism) of E(duard) von Hartmann 2[207] 9%26 Beginning Conclusion. To what extent this self-annihilation of morality is still a part of its own force. We Europeans have in us the blood of those who have died for their faith; we have taken morality as terrible and serious and there is nothing that we have not at some time sacrificed to it. On the other hand: our spiritual subtlety has been achieved essentially through conscience-vivisection. We do not yet know the Where to? toward which we are driven, now that we have detached ourselves in this manner from our old soil. But this very soil cultivated in us the strength that now drives us out into the distance, into adventure (by which we) are thrust out into the boundless, unexplored, undiscovered — we [Page 409] 402 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS have no choice, we must be conquerors once we no longer have a country where we are at home, where we could “subsist.” No, you know this better, my friends! The hidden Yes in you is stronger than all the No’s and Maybe’s from which you and your times are sick and addicted; and if you must ship out, you emigrants, then a faith compels you to do so — — 2[208] the not-finishings with Christianity 2[209] It is a point of honor for my friends to be active on behalf of my name, reputation and worldly security and to build me a fortress where I am preserved from being crudely misjudged: I personally do not want to lift a finger for this anymore 2[210] The perfect functional certainty of the regulating instincts [Page 41] 34 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS of character,” in plain language perhaps laziness, and on the other hand his faith in the infallibility of genius (in plain language perhaps vanity) prompted him to prematurely pronounce holy the “sin of his youth,” I mean his metaphysics of the will; and to no longer “develop” himself. A h(uman being) of his talent and inner discordia?! had the substance for five “better” systems in his head, and one ever truer and falsier than the other. 34[118] We do not understand a “causal” relationship, but we see that a factum, in order to be established, (should) comprehend several facta” in itself. Our analysis sets up a succession. The numbers that are generated by this mean nothing for the relationship of those phenomena among themselves, but could lead astray: because humanity is fixed in some instincts, a similarity of numerical ratios is yielded with respect to him. 34[119] Do our thoughts stand in a causal direct relationship to others? Or is their logical connection an illusion? I mean a result of the fact that the instigating

events of each of these thoughts stand in a relationship that presents itself to us as “conclusion” and the like. They are purely final links? — Or is there a direct effect of a thought on another? A “causing” here at least? 34[120] The world of appearance “empty illusion and deception,” the need for causality that produces connections between appearances likewise “empty illusion and deception” — with this moral condemnation of the deceptive and the illusory voices itself. One has to get beyond this. There are no things in themselves, also no absolute knowing, the perspectival, deceiving character belongs to existence.” [Page 410] [3 = WI 7b. Wb. Mp XVI 2b. Mp XVI 1b. Beginning 1886—Spring 1886] On the Natural History of the Free Spirit. On the Natural History of the Free Spirit. Thoughts and Dashes by Friedrich Nietzsche. 313] Dedication and Final Verse.” “To him who makes all heavens bright And causes all the seas to roar — ” 314) The Will to Power. Omen of a Philosophy of the Future. By Friedrich Nietzsche. 3s] Misunderstanding of the lust to rule. Cheerfulness as redemption. [Page 411] 404 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS Dance. Mockery of “divine” — symptom of convalescence. The demand for “solid facts” — epistemology how much pessimism there is in it! Creating Z(arathustra) as one’s opponent 316]? Love of the fatherland is something young in Europe and it still stands on weak legs: it falls down easily! One should not let oneself be deceived by the clamor it makes: little children scream the loudest. 317] “Stupid to the point of holiness” they say in Russia.° 318)” Toward New Seas. All Sorts of Questions and Questionable Matters. for Good Europeans. By Friedrich Nietzsche. Beyond Good and Evil. Prelude to a Philosophy of the Future. First Book: Morality and Knowledge. Second Book: Morality and Religion. Third Book: Morality and Art. Fourth Book: Our Virtues. Fifth Book: On the Order of Rank. [Page 412] 3 BEGINNING 1886—SPRING 1886 405 3[10]? Our Virtues. All Manner of Questions for the Questionable. By Friedrich Nietzsche. 3[11]° Human, All Too Human. A Book for Free Spirits. New Sequel. And if this book is a mirror and consequently an opportunity for self-mirroring: well, you good Europeans, what do h sake ee: : as you think of our vanity? Does it like to see itself — “in the mirror”? — 312] From the natural history of the free spirit.”’ The philosophy of the future. Scientific laborers. Artists. On the philosophy of the superior human. On the dimming of Europe.!” 3[13] It is this solitude that we guard when we speak of the religious organization of humankind: — and perhaps nothing distinguishes us so distinctly from the herd animals and equality apostles mistakenly called “free spirits”: — all of whom could not bear solitude. Religion conceived as the continuation and deepening of fundamental political theory, which is always the theory of unequal rights, of the necessity of a social structure with High and Low, with commanders and obeyers: to us [Page 413] 406 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS religion means the theory of the difference in rank of souls, of the cultivation and possibility of higher souls at the expense of

the lower. 3[14] The world is not worth that which we have believed: we have figured it out. The pessimist even lets us know that precisely this is the remaining value that it holds for us, namely that we can figure it out — and that it is not worth that which we believed. In this manner the world would be a means of spoiling the world for oneself, of “deworliding” oneself in the best possible manner; an absurdity that is finally starting to comprehend itself after mis(er)able detours, a somewhat long-winded comedy of errors that shamefully loses itself in nothingness 3L] There remains enough to object to in a long invalidism; I am least inclined to agree with a Christian moralist that it improves a h{uman), namely if he is afflicted with protracted pains that one (observes) with cold presence of mind — neither that Oriental mute deaf self-dissolving, self-surrendering nor that over-exciting of the power of will and of bravery that {displays} pride, scorn to such an enemy as is pain — — — In the midst of long agonies, burned as it were with green wood and without the benefit that fever, faintings — — — 3[16] Manzoni Stifter (G. Keller) 3[17]° “Maledetto colui — che contrista un spirito immortal Manzoni (Act II of Conte di Carmagnola) [Page 414] 3 BEGINNING 1886—SPRING 1886 407 3[18]!° gangasrotogati “flowing like the current of the Ganges” = presto® kurmagati “moving like the tortoise” = lento” mandeikagati “moving like the frog” = staccato®” 3[19] We philosophers of the beyond — of beyond good and evil, if I may!, who in truth are shrewd interpreters and diviners — we whose fate it was as spectators of European things to be placed before a mysterious and unread text: which reveals itself to us more and more — what a chore we have in remaining silent and keeping our mouths shut, while ever more and rarer things crowd up in us and pile up in us and yearn for light, air, freedom, words! But the word — — — [Page 415] [4 = D 18. Mp XV 2c. Mp XVII 3a. Mp XVI 1b. Beginning 1886—Spring 1886] 4i] A philosopher: what a modest creature if he really stays true to his name! — which does not characterize a “friend of wisdom,” forgive an old philologist! but only “someone who likes wise men.” Therefore if you want there to be philosophers in the Greek sense and meaning of the word, first bring on your “wise men”! — But it seems to me, my friends, that we ultimately love the unwise men more than the wise, supposing even there were any wise men —? And perhaps there, right there lies more wisdom? What? Should even the wise themselves — seen from up close, perhaps — not be “philosophers”? But “philosophers”?!. Friends of folly, good company for itinerant musicians and foolish folk? And not for — themselves? — 4[2] On the problem of the mask. “Une croyance presque instinctive chez moi, cest que tout homme puissant ment, quand il parle, et a plus forte raison, quand il écrit”? Stendhal, Vie de Napoléon, Préface p. XV. 4b] “Je sais, quel est le pouvoir des hommes,” said Napoleon on St. Helena; “les plus grands ne peuvent exiger d’être aimés”? — Let us immediately add what can be suspected for all too good [Page 416] 4

BEGINNING I-SPRING 1886 409 reasons: they do not even demand it of themselves — and they also do not love themselves! 4 414] “You seem to be up to something wicked, one could believe you wanted to drive human beings to ruin?” — I once said to the god Dionysus. “Perhaps,” replied the god, “but in such a way that they get something out of it for themselves.” — “What then?” I asked, curious. — “Who then? you should be asking.” Thus spoke Dionysus and he grew silent, in the way that is his own, namely seductively. — You should have seen him then! It was spring, and all the trees were in their early sap. 41s] There is a part of the night of which a hermit will say: “listen, now time is stopping!” In all night watches, especially if one finds oneself on unusual nocturnal travels and wanderings, one has with respect to this part of night (I mean the hours from one to three) an odd astonished feeling, a kind of “much too short!” or “much too long!”, in sum, the impression of a time-anomaly. Could it be that in those hours, as people who are awake for a change, we have to do penance for the fact that we usually find ourselves in the time-chaos of the dream world at that time? Enough, at night from one to three we “have no clock in our heads.” To me it seems that this is precisely what the ancients expressed with “*intempestiva nocte*” and “*Ἐν &weovuxti*”> (Aeschylus), thus “there in the night where time does not exist”; and I also etymologically use this thought to explain to myself an obscure word of Homer for describing the deepest stillest part of the night, even if the translators believe they have reproduced it with “time of the night milking”: — where in the whole wide world were people ever stupid enough to milk the cows at night between one and three! — But to whom do you tell your night thoughts anyway? — [Page 417] 410 UNPUBLISHED

FRAGMENTS 4{6}° (In) marriages in the bourgeois sense of the word, mind you in the most respectable sense of the word “marriage,” it is not at all a matter of love, just as little as it is a matter of money — no institution can be made out of love —: rather, it is a matter of the social permission granted to two persons for their mutual sexual gratification, under conditions, as is self-evident, but those that have the interest of society in mind. It is plain as day that among the prerequisites that will belong to such a contract are a degree of pleasure on the part of the participants and very much good will — will to patience, compatibility, caring for one another; but one should not misuse the word love for this! For two lovers in the complete and strong sense of the word sexual gratification is simply not essential and really only a symbol, for one party, as mentioned, a symbol of unconditional submission, for the other a symbol of consent to it, a sign of taking possession. — In a marriage in the aristocratic, old-aristocratic sense of the word it is a matter of the breeding of a race (does aristocracy still exist today? *Quaeritur*) — thus of maintaining a fixed, specific type of ruling human being: man and woman were sacrificed to this point of view. It is self-evident that for this love was not the first requirement, on the

contrary! and not even that measure of good will for one another that conditions the good bourgeois marriage. The interest of a family was primarily decisive, and beyond it — the class. We would shiver a bit at the coldness, severity and calculating clarity of such a noble concept of marriage as reigned in every healthy aristocracy, in ancient Athens as still in the Europe of the eighteenth century, we warm-blooded animals with our delicate hearts, we “moderns”! This is precisely why love as passion, according to the broad understanding of the word, was invented for the aristocratic world and in it — there, where precisely the compulsion, the privation were greatest . . . [Page 418] 4 BEGINNING I— SPRING 1886 All 4(7)\$ — “Illness makes people better”: this famous assertion that one encounters throughout all centuries, indeed from the mouths of the wise just as from the mouths and maws of the people, gives us something to think about. One is tempted to ask for once, with respect to its validity: is there perhaps a causal bond between morality and illness generally? The “improvement of human beings” regarded on the whole, for example the undeniable softening humanizing good-naturing of the European within the last millennium — is it perhaps the consequence of a long mysterious-uncanny? suffering and failing, privation, atrophy? Has “illness” “made” the European “better”? Or asked differently: is our morality — our modern tender morality in Europe — which one may compare with the morality of the Chinese — the expression of a physiological regression? . . . For one would not be able to deny that every place in history where “the human being” has shown himself in the special magnificence and power of his type immediately assumes a sudden, dangerous, eruptive character in which humanity was badly off; and perhaps in those cases where it seems to be otherwise there was simply a lack of courage or subtlety to practice psychology to the depths and to extract the universal principle there as well: “the healthier, stronger, richer, more fruitful, more enterprising a human being feels, the more ‘immoral’ (he) also becomes.” A painful thought! on which one should absolutely not dwell! But supposing one were to run forward with it for a brief little moment, how astonishedly one gazes into the future there! Then what would have been purchased more dearly than precisely that which we are promoting with all our strength — the humanization, the “improvement,” the growing “civilization”!® of the human being? Nothing would be more costly than virtue: for in the end it would have the earth as hospital: and “everyone the nurse of everyone” would be wisdom’s last verdict.!! To be sure: then one would also have that long sought-after “peace on earth”! But also so little “delight in one another”!?’ So little [Page 419] 412 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS beauty, exuberance, daring, danger! So few “works,” for whose sake it would still be worth it to live on earth! Oh! and no “deeds” at all anymore! All great works and deeds that have remained standing and were not washed away by the waves of time — were they not all in the deepest sense of the word great immoralities? ..

4[8] That the mere strength of a belief guarantees nothing at all with respect to its truth, indeed is even capable of slowly, slowly spinning forth a fat stupidity from the most reasonable of things: this is our genuine European insight — in it, if in anything, we have become experienced, burned, shrewd, wise, through much damage, as it seems . . . “Belief makes blessed”: good! Sometimes at least! But under all circumstances belief makes stupid, even in the rarer case when it is not, when from the start it is a clever belief. Every long-held belief finally becomes stupid, that means, expressed with the clarity of our modern psychologists, its reasons sink “into the unconscious,” they disappear in it — henceforth it no longer rests on reasons, but on affects (that is in the event that it needs help, it lets the affects fight for it and no longer the reasons). Assuming one could ascertain what is the best-believed, longest-held, least controversial, most honest belief there is among human beings, one would be permitted to speculate with a high degree of probability that it was at the same time also the profoundest, most stupid, “most unconscious” belief, best defended against reasons, and abandoned by reasons for the longest time. — Admittedly; but what is this belief? — Oh you curious ones! But now that I have let myself open for riddle-solving I want to be humane and quickly provide you with an answer and a solution — they won’t be easily anticipated from me. The human being is above all a judging animal; but in judgment lies our oldest and most constant belief, in all judging there is a fundamental holding-true of things and an asserting, a certainty that something is so and not otherwise, that here [Page 42] 34 APRIL-JUNE 1885 35 34 [121]”⁴ That my appreciation or condemnation of a person does not give another person a right to the same appreciation or condemnation: — unless he is equal to me and of the same rank. The opposite manner of thinking is that of newspapers: that the appreciation of people and things is something “in itself,” for which anyone is allowed to reach as if for his property. Here is simply the assumption that all are of equal rank. — Being truthful is a distinction 34[122] That something that originated is not known when one knows its origin?’ (father and mother): but instead that one must already know it in order to discover something “related” in the conditions of origin — and that mostly this is an illusion: — for in truth the recognition of the paternal and maternal element in the child is possible only in an aggregate, and involuntarily we seek, in order to explain, to comprehend something new only as an aggregate, an ordering-together i.e., the analysis refers not to the real origin, but to a fake “mechanistic” ordering-together and addition that did not happen at all. The explainer takes the facts as more stupid and simpler than they are. 34[123] That a human being is a multiplicity of forces that stand in an order of rank, so that there are commanders, but that the commander must also create everything that serves the preservation of the obeyers, such that he is conditioned by their existence. All these living beings must be of a related kind, otherwise they could not serve and obey one another so: the commanders”

in some sense must also be obeyers, and in more subtle cases the role between them must change temporarily, and he who otherwise commands must obey for once. The concept “individual”? is false. These beings do not exist at all [Page 420] 4 BEGINNING I—SPRING 1886 413 the human being has really “known”: what is it that in every judgment is unconsciously believed to be true? — That we have a right to differentiate between subject and predicate, between cause and effect — that is our strongest belief; indeed at bottom even the belief in cause and effect, in *conditio* and *conditionatum*TM is only an individual case of the first and universal belief, our primal belief in subject and predicate (namely as the claim that every effect is an action and that every conditioned thing presupposes a conditioner, every action a doer, in sum, a subject) Should this belief in the subject- and predicate-concept not (be a big stupidity?) 41]*

Afterlude. — But here you interrupt me, you free spirits. “Enough! Enough!” I hear you shouting and laughing, “we cannot take it anymore! Oh this horrific tempter and disturber of the conscience’s peace! Do you want to ruin our reputation throughout the world? Blacken our good name? Saddle us with nicknames that eat their way into not only our skin? — And why, on a bright sunny day, these gloomy ghosts, these moral gurgling noises, this whole tragic raven-black music? If you speak truths: there are no feet that could dance to such truths, therefore not by a long shot are they truths for us! Ecce nostrum veritatis sigillum! And here there is lawn and soft ground: what would be better than to swiftly chase away your mopey thoughts and make ourselves a good day after your night? It is finally time that a rainbow stretched itself again over this land, and that someone gave us gentle crazy songs to hear and milk to drink: — we all are thirsty again for a pious, heartfelt-silly and milky way of thinking.” — My friends, I see that you are losing my patience — and who is telling you that I have not already waited a long time for that? But I am at your disposal; and I also have what you need. Do you not see there my herds leaping, all my tender sunny sheltered thoughtlambs and thought-rams? And here standing waiting for you [Page 421] 414 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS already is a whole pail full of milk; but once you have drunk — for you are all thirsting for virtue, I see it — then there will be no lack of songs as you wish them! To start with a dancing song for the merriest legs and hearts: and truly, whoever sings it does honor to One who deserves honor, one of the freest of free spirits, who makes all heavens bright again and causes all the seas to roar. — [Page 422] Reference Matter [Page 424] Notes The following symbols are used throughout the text and notes:

~ a — we et Italics Bold NL Deletion by Nietzsche Addition by Nietzsche Addition by the translators Addition by the editors (Colli and Montinari) Unfinished or incomplete sentence or thought Underlined once by Nietzsche Underlined twice or more by Nietzsche Books in Nietzsche’s personal library Variants and editions of Nietzsche’s works are referred to by the following

abbreviations: CW The Complete Works of Friedrich Nietzsche Briefwechsel: Kritische Gesamtausgabe Werke: Kritische Gesamtausgabe Werke: Kritische Studienausgabe Twenty-volume 1894 Leipzig edition of Nietzsche's works (Großoktav-Ausgabe) Preliminary draft Printer's manuscript (clean final copy of handwritten MS) [Page 425] 418 NOTES Sd Second draft Se Subsequent emendation Titles of Nietzsche's works are referred to by the following abbreviations: AC The Antichrist BGE Beyond Good and Evil BT The Birth of Tragedy D Dawn DD Dionysus Dithyrambs DS David Strauss the Confessor and the Writer EH Ecce Homo GM On the Genealogy of Morality HAH Human, All Too Human AL On the Utility and Liability of History for Life JS The Joyful Science MM Mixed Opinions and Maxims NCW Nietzsche Contra Wagner SE Schopenhauer as Educator TI Twilight of the Idols UO Unfashionable Observations WA The Wagner Case WB Richard Wagner in Bayreuth WP The Will to Power WS The Wanderer and His Shadow Z Thus Spoke Zarathustra Editorial Note to Volume 16 Unless another volume in the CW is cited, all cross-references to fragments in the notes are references to fragments in this volume. In cases where a cross-reference to a fragment is followed by a number (e.g., 41[2] 1), this indicates that the reference is to the sentence or paragraph numbered 1 in fragment 41[2]. [Page 426] NOTES TO PAGES I-3 419 In cases where the format of a fragment in this volume differs significantly from the format of the fragment as it appears in KSA, we have chosen to follow as closely as possible the format of the fragment as it appears in Nietzsche's handwritten notebooks. ALAN D. SCHRIFT [34 =N VII 1] 1. Cf. 34[1]; 35184]; 36[6]. 2. Gai saber.] "Gay science." {The Old Provençal term for the art of the troubadours.} 3. {Cf CW 15, 26[426] and the corresponding note.} 4. Cf. 41[2] 15 41[9]. 5. On BT. 6. {Cf. Stendhal, Correspondance inédites: Précédée d'une introduction par Prosper Mérimée ("Unpublished correspondence: Preceded with an introduction by Prosper Mérimée") (Paris: Michel Lévy Frères, 1855), I: 167; cf. Hippolyte Taine, Geschichte der englischen Literatur ("History of English literature"), German edition by L. Katscher und G. Gerth, vol. 3: Die Neuzeit der englischen Literatur ("The modern age of English literature") (Leipzig: Ernst Julius Günther Nachf., 1880), 136.} 7. Cf. 3401]. 8. niaiserie] "silliness" 9. "femininisme"] "feminism" {N here uses his French neologism *femininisme* to render his own German neologism *femininismus*, which he preferred to the more standard *feminismus*.} 10. {Cf. Blaise Pascal, Pascal's Gedanken, Fragmente und Briefe ("Pascal's thoughts, fragments, and letters"), German trans. by C. F. Schwartz (Leipzig: Wigand, 1865), 1:193, NL: "Lustravit lampade terras. Das Wetter und meine Stimmung haben wenig Berührungspunkte. Meine Stimmung hängt ganz und gar nicht von der Witterung ab. Ich habe meine Nebel und mein schönes Wetter in meinem Innern." ("He has illumined the earth with a lamp. The weather and my mood have little connection. My mood does not depend entirely

on the weather. I have my foggy and my fine weather within me.”)} [Page 427] 420 NOTES TO PAGES 3—7 u. milieu] {Taine’s use of the expression *race, milieu et moment* was familiar to N, who corresponded with Taine and spoke highly of him (cf. BGE 254; GM III 19).} 12. {Cf. BGE 247} 13. WP 133 adds in the text the following supplement, provided by Peter Gast, to Galiani’s quote: “La prévoyance est la cause des guerres actuelles de l’Europe. {Gast omits the following line from Galiani’s quote: “Parce qu’on prévoit que la maison d’Autriche s’agrandira; que les Américains, dans quelques siècles d’ici, que les Anglais, les Français, les Espagnols, dans cent ans, feront ou ne feront pas certaines choses, on commence par s’égorger à l’instant.”} Si Pon voulait se donner la peine de rien prévoir, tout le monde serait tranquille, et je ne crois pas qu’on serait plus malheureux parce qu’on ne ferait pas la guerre.” {“Foresight is the cause of Europe’s present wars. Because we predict that the House of Austria will expand; that the Americans, in a few centuries hence, the English, the French, the Spanish, in a hundred years, will or will not do certain things, we begin by immediately cutting each other’s throats. If one would take pains to foresee nothing, the whole world would be tranquil, and I do not believe that one would be worse off for not waging war.”} {Ferdinando Galiani, *Lettres de l’Abbé Galiani à Madame d’Epinay*, Voltaire, Diderot, Grimm, le Baron d’Holbach, Morellet, Suart, D’Alembert, Marmontel, la Vicomtesse de Belsunce, etc., vol. 2 (Paris: G. Charpentier, 1881), 323.} 14. {Cf. WP 133.} Cf. CW 15, 32[12]; CW 18, 13[5]. 15. {Cf. BGE 254. 16. Beyle} {Marie-Henri Beyle, pseudonym of Stendhal.} 17. Allusion to Gustave Flaubert {author of *Salammbé* (1862), which N here misspells, and *The Temptation of Saint Anthony* (1874)}. 18. *pro pudor!*] “for shame!” 19. Cf. CW 15, 26[467]. 20. the being] *das Seiende* 21. Cf. 34[201, 207]. 22. *acedia*] {a state of restlessness and inability either to work or to pray} [Page 428] NOTES TO PAGES 7-18 421 23. {Cf. Lefebvre Saint-Ogan, *Essai sur l’influence française: Deuxième édition* (“Essay on the influence of the French: Second edition”) (Paris: Cerf, 1885), 18-19. NL.} 24. {Cf. *ibid.*, 49.} 25. “they... do.”] Cf. Luke 23:34. 26. *façon*] “manner” 27. *Plaire*] “to please” {Underlined by N.} 28. {Cf. Saint-Ogan, 178.} 29. High Mass] {Also known as the Mass in B minor.} 30. {Cf. WP Go. Cf. Saint-Ogan, 248-50.} 31. Cf. *ibid.*, 248. Goethe’s judgment in *Dichtung und Wahrheit*, pt. 3, bk. 11. {Cf. *Goethes Werke*, bd. IX, ed. Erich Trunz (Hamburg: Christian Wegner Verlag, 1955), 487.} 32. Galiani] Cf. Saint-Ogan, 194. 33. Cf. 38[6]; Baudelaire’s judgment about Victor Hugo in Charles-Augustin Saint-Beuve, *Les Cahiers suivis de quelques pages de littérature antique* (“The notebooks followed by some pages of ancient literature”) (Paris: Alphonse Lemerre, 1876), 36, NL. 34. *causa finalis . . . causa efficiens*] “final cause . . . efficient cause” 35. {WP 413} 36. Cf. BGE 11; 38[7]. {Cf. Kant’s introduction to the 2nd ed. of *Critique of Pure Reason*, trans. Allen Wood (Cambridge: Cambridge University

Press, 1998), 146.} 37. good science] Wissenschaftlichkeit 38. ulterior motives... to ruin.] {"Uterior motives" = Hintergedanken; "dashes" = Gedankenstriche; "freedom of thought" = Freiheit des Gedankens; "thinkers" = Denker. N uses combinations of nouns based on denken, "to think."} 39. ironice] "ironically" {Underlined by N.} 40. back parts and foregrounds] Hintertheilen und Vorder griinden 41. Cf. BGE 208. 42. Cf. 37[14]. 43. Kant's words] Cf. Kritik der reinen Vernunft, Ak.-Ausgabe II: 496 {Critique of Pure Reason, 225, 654}. 4. {Cf. Maximilian Drossbach, Ueber die scheinbaren und die 'in blichen Ursachen des Geschehens in der Welt ("On the Apparent and real causes of events in the world") (Halle: Pfeffer, 1884), 2. NL.} [Page 429] 422 NOTES TO PAGES 18-26 45. contradictio in adjecto] "contradiction in terms" 46. {WP 973.} 47. the plant "human being") {Cf. note to 34[146].} 48. Cf. 34[145]. 49. Cf. BGE 11; 38[7]. 50. {Kant says this in the preface to Prolegomena to Any Future Metaphysics; cf. Friedrich Albert Lange, Geschichte des Materialismus und Kritik seiner Bedeutung in der Gegenwart ("History of materialism and critique of its significance in the present") (Iserlohn: Baedeker, 1882), 396. NL.} 51. delicatessen] "delicacy," "tact" {Underlined by N.} 52. nihil humani] "nothing of the human" {Cf. Terence, "Homo sum, humani nihil a me alienum puto" ("I am human, and think nothing of the human is alien to me"), which appears in his play Heauton Timorumenos (The Self-Tormentor; 163 BCE).} 53. Cf. BGE 11; 38[7]. 54. {Cf. Galiani, Lettres de Abbé Galiani à Madame d'Epinay, 279.} 55. {Cf. Drossbach, 8—9.} 56. Tübingen Seminary] {Seminary in Tübingen attended by Hegel, Hölderlin, Schelling.} 57. avdpvnots] "anamnesis" 58. {Cf. Francis Galton, Inquiries into Human Faculty and Its Development (London: Macmillan, 1883), 73-74.} 59. esprit] "spirit" 60. civis romanus . . . imperium romanum] "citizen of Rome... Roman empire" 61. Cf. BGE 268. 62. amor] "love" {Underlined by N.} 63. "Nibelungs"] {Richard Wagner's cycle of four operas, collectively called Der Ring des Nibelungen (The Ring of the Nibelung), consisting of Das Rheingold (The Rhine Gold), Die Walküre (The Valkyrie), Siegfried, and Götterdämmerung (Twilight of the Gods). These operas premiered as a cycle at the first Bayreuth Festival of 1876 and are often referred to as The Ring, less often as The Nibelungs.} 64. The Germans... press.] {Cf. BGE preface.} 65. aeternae] "eternal" [Page 43] 36 UNPUBLISHED FRAGMENTS in isolation: the center of gravity is something changeable; the constant producing of cells etc. yields a constant change in the number of these beings. And by adding nothing at all is accomplished. Our arithmetic is something too crude for this relationship and only an individual arithmetic. 34[124] The logic of our conscious thinking is only a crude and simplified form of that thinking which is required by our organism, indeed by its individual organs. A simultaneous thinking e.g., is needed, of which we scarcely have an inkling. Perhaps an artist of language: the reckoning back with the heaviness and lightness of syllables, the

reckoning ahead, simultaneously the analogy-seeking of the weight of the thought with the tonal or the physiological or larynx conditions happen simultaneously — but of course not as conscious. Our causality feeling is something quite crude and isolated compared to the real causal feelings of our organism. In particular the “before” and “after” are a great naïveté. Lastly: we must first gain everything for consciousness, a temporal sense, a spatial sense, causal sense: after it had existed much more richly for a long time without consciousness. And of course a certain most simple plain reduced form: our conscious willing, feeling, thinking is in the service of a much more comprehensive willing feeling and thinking. — Really? We are constantly still growing, our temporal-spatial sense etc. is still developing. 34] Nothing can be prophesied, but with a certain enhancement of the type human being a new force can reveal itself, of which we knew nothing so far. (Namely a synthesis of opposites?) 34[126]”⁸ The sigh of Kleist over ultimate unknowability — °° [Page 430] NOTES TO PAGES 26—33 423 66. “féminisme”] “feminism” {Cf. note 9 above.} 67. WP 955. 68. absorption] Bindung; WP 955 erroneously printed this as Bildung {“education,” “cultivation’}. 69. Cf. CW 18, 15[34]. 70. {WP 962.} 71. The astonishment... poet!] Cf. BGE 209. 72. N is quoting from Lange, *Geschichte des Materialismus*, {820}. 73. let the... but the men’] {Let the little children come to Me”; Matthew 19:14.} 74. Cf. BGE 28 and 247. 75. allegro] “lively” 76. presto] “rapid” 77. il principe] {Machiavelli’s *The Prince*} 78. Cf. 35[80], 36[55]; for this planned book: 34[104—6, 114-15, 138, 145, 154, 157, 221, 227-28]. 79. To 3403]. 80. To 34[103]. 81. To 34[103]; cf 34[102, 97]. 82. Epicureisme] “Epicureanism” 3. homines novi] “new men” {In ancient Rome, the first man in a family to serve in the senate.} 84. To 34[103]; cf. 36[45]. 85. {WP 900.} : 86. To 34[103], in the manuscript attached to Pd for BGE 244. 87. To 34[103] {cf. 36[46—47]; 40170]; 41[16]; 42[1-3, 6]}. 88. The “Mind.”] Das “Gemiith.” {Cf. Johann Wolfgang von Goethe, *Maximen und Reflexionen*, in *Goethe’s sämtliche Werke in vierzig Bänden* (“Goethe’s collected works in forty volumes”), vol. 3 (Stuttgart: J. G. Cotta, 1853), 196. NL.} 89. niaiserie allemande] “German silliness” {Cf. Prosper Mérimée, *Lettres a une inconnue* (“Letters to an Unknown [Jenny Dacquin]”), vol. 1 (Paris: Michel Lévy Frères, 1874), 328, where Mérimée uses this phrase in a reference to Goethe. Schopenhauer uses the phrase “Deutscher [German] Niaiserie” in reference to Hegel’s philosophy in *Die Welt als Wille und Vorstellung*, vol. 1 (Leipzig: Brockhaus, 1873), 508; translated by Judith Norman, Alistair Welchman, and [ee] [Page 431] 424 NOTES TO PAGES 33—42 Christopher Janaway as *The World as Will and Representation* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2010), 456.} 90. {Cf. Gustav Teichmüller, *Die wirkliche und die scheinbare Welt: Neue Grundlegung der Metaphysik* {The real and the apparent world: New groundwork of metaphysic”} (Breslau: Koebner, 1882),

139.} 91. discordia] “discord,” “chaos” 92. facta] “facts” 93. {Cf. Drossbach, Ueber die scheinbaren und die wirklichen Ursachen des Geschehens in der Welt, 10.3 94. {Cf. BGE 43.} 95. origin] Entstehung {Here and elsewhere in this fragment.} 96. commanders] Dienenden {N actually wrote “the servants in some sense must also be obeyers,” but clearly it was his intention to juxtapose servants with commanders, not servants with obeyers, since the latter are the same. The ones who exchange roles are commanders and obeyers.} 97. “individual”] “Individuum” 98. Cf. Heinrich von Kleist to Wilhelmine and Ulrike {Wilhemine von Zenge (1780—1852) was Kleist’s fiancée, Ulrike (1774-1849) his half-sister}, 22-23 March 1801, quoted by N in SE 2 {CW 2, 188}. 99. unknowability] {Heinrich von Kleist was distressed throughout his brief and tumultuous career by his understanding of the Kantian treatment of knowledge; his characters (prose, drama) frequently function on the basis of desperate faith in the absence of knowledge.} 100. Cf. 34[188]. 1o. Intelligence] Geistigkeit 102. {Cf. Drossbach, Ueber die scheinbaren und die wirklichen Ursachen des Geschehens in der Welt, 10.} 103. “perceiving”] wahrnehmen {“to perceive,” consisting of wahr (true) and nehmen (to take)} 104. New Zarathustra plan; cf. 35[71-75]. 105. perished] unter gieng 106. Cf. 34[78]; 35139-41, 71-75]; 34[191]. 107. Cf. BGE 44. 108. plant “human being”) According to Vittorio Alfieri’s statement: “La pianta uomo nasce più robusta qui che altrove” {“The [Page 432] NOTES TO PAGES 42—48 425 plant human being is born more robust here [in Italy] than anywhere else”}, quoted in Stendhal, Rome, Naples et Florence (Paris: Michel Lévy Frères,} 1854), 383, NL; the quote is underlined by N. 109. Cf. BGE 4s. uo. Cf. CW 18, 11[296], 18[3]; BGE 254}. 111. blue flower] {The blue flower (die blaue Blume) is symbolic of Romanticism and is featured as the object of the mysterious quest of Heinrich von Ofterdingen, the titular hero of Novalis’s (Friedrich von Hardenberg) Romantic novel.} 112. The Parisians] {Heinrich Heine lived in exile in Paris, supported by a stipend from the French government. His writings and those of other “Young Germans” were banned in Germany. Cf. Edmond and Jules de Goncourt, Idées et sensations (Paris: Charpentier, 1877), 219: “L’esprit le plus parisien qu’ait eu la France est l’esprit français des étrangers: de Galiani, du prince de Ligne, d’Henri Heine.” (“The most Parisian spirit in France has been the French spirit of foreigners: Galiani, the Prince of Ligne, Heinrich Heine.”) NL.} 113. Cf. 34[159-60]. 114. To 34[155]. uş. Cf. BGE 209. 116. homines religiosi] “religious men” u. {Cf. BGE 15.} 118. reductio ad absurdum] “reduction to absurdity” ug. Cf. 34[155]. 120. The... Prerogatives.] Das Recht der Vorrechte. 121. {Cf WP 75.} 122. virtù) “strength” {from Latin vir, “man”} 123. {Cf WP 75.} 124. someone presented himself] trat man selber auf {from auftreten “to appear,” to “present itself”} 125. kick!] Tritt! {“kick,” derived from treten, “to kick,” and by wordplay from vertreten, “to represent”} 126. The two... democracy.] {Cf. BGE

preface.} 127. {WP 762.} 128. Cf. 35[78]; 42[1]. 129. peintre-poète] “painter-poet” [Page 433] 426 NOTES TO PAGES 48-55 130. Coriolan overture] {The Coriolan Overture was composed by Ludwig van Beethoven in 1807 for Heinrich Joseph von Collin’s 1804 tragedy Coriolan.} 131. The expression expression] Die Ausdruck expression {N underlines “Ausdruck”; the second mention is French in the original.} 132. liberum “nego”] “I freely ‘deny’”; perhaps based on Liberum veto, “I freely forbid” or “free veto.” {The liberum veto was a parliamentary device in the Polish-Lithuanian Commonwealth (1648-1764) that gave any member of the legislature the right to call an end to the session and nullify any legislation that had been passed during the session.} 133. {Cf Drossbach, Ueber die scheinbaren und die wirklichen Ursachen des Geschehens in der Welt, 9. Cf. BGE 4.} 134. Nux et Crux] “nut and cross” 135. the “people”] das “Volk” 136. bonhomie] “good-naturedness” 137. {Cf. Galton, Inquiries into Human Faculty and Its Development, 72} 138. Moralities... customs.] {WP 144.} 139. the plant human being] Cf. note 108 above. 140. kind] Art, “kind,” or possibly “species” 141. {WP 753.} 142. {WP 961.} 143. Cf. BGE 295; 41]. 144. nakedness] {Cf. Genesis 3:7.} 145. Cf. 34[181, 213]. 146. Cf. Matthew 7:14. 147. how are live children . . . slumber] {N here and in the remainder of this fragment parodies Kant by invoking the Critique of Pure Reason (“How are synthetic judgments a priori possible?”) and the Prolegomena to Any Future Metaphysics (where he credits David Hume for interrupting his “dogmatic slumber”).} 148. the god] On the “Philosophy of Dionysus,” cf. 3.4[181]. 149. Cf. BGE 1; 34[79]. 150. “random willing”] Willelei 151. {Cf. Friedrich Schiller, “Die Künstler” (“The Artists”), in Sämtliche Werke: Erstes Bändchen (Stuttgart: J. G. Cotta, 1822), 179. NL.} [Page 434] NOTES TO PAGES 55-64 427 152. Cf. 34[129]. 153. comme une neurose] “like a neurosis” 154. bonté] “kindness” 155. Cf. 34[188, 129]. 156. Science and Conscience.] Wissen und Gewissen. 157. To 34[t]. 158. Knowing] das Wissen 159. Felix Fallax.] “Happy Deceiver.” 160. {Cf. WP 409.} 161. contradictio in adjecto] “contradiction in terms” 162. satis... nullus.] “Few suffice for me, one suffices for me, none at all suffices for me.” {Seneca, Epistulae morales ad Lucilium, bk. 1, letter 7.} 163. uévno’ dscvoteiv] “remember not to trust” {Part of a line from the Greek comic playwright Epicharmus, quoted by Polybius and by Cicero in his Letters to Atticus (1.19); also attributed to Epicharmus in Lucian’s Hermotimus; cf. Kaibel fragment 250.} 164. To 34[145]. 165. the children . . . come.] {Cf. the conclusion of Z, where Zarathustra has signs that “his children” are near.} 166. theswarm comes] {Cf. the conclusion of Z, where a swarm of doves, along with the lion, symbolize the imminent arrival of Zarathustra’s children.} 167. Cf. 34[33, 191, 207]. 168. To 34[20]; cf. 35[72]. 169. da capo] “play it again,” “encore” 170. Cf. 35[49]. 171. little treatise] = WB 172. Bayreuther Blätter] {Journal of the Wagner society and festival established in

Bayreuth. See p. 433, note 11.) 173. Cf. 34[212, 209]. 174. Century of fairs] Jahrmarkts-Jahrhundert 175. Cf. 34[33, 201]. 176. Cf. 34[206, 212]. 177. fairgrounds-taste] Jahbrmarkts-Geschmack 178. in the age of fairs] Cf. 34[206, 209]. 179. Cf. 34[1, 182]; 35[84]; 36[1, 6]; 34194]; CW 15, 30[t]; 34[202, 201]. D [Page 435] 428 NOTES TO PAGES 64—69 180. Reich-foolishness] Reichs-Narrheit {folly or foolishness concerning the (Second) Reich} 181. eg., ... case] {Cf. William Henry Rolph, *Biologische Probleme: Zugleich als Versuch zur Entwicklung einer rationellen Ethik* (“Biological problems: At the same time an attempt at a rational ethics”) (Leipzig: Engelmann, 1884), 148: “Ich selbst fasse die Parthenogenese (. . .) als eine ganz allgemeine Erscheinung auf, dagegen aber eigentlich die sexuelle Fortpflanzung als eine exceptionelle.” (“I myself interpret parthenogenesis . . . as an entirely general phenomenon, conversely, however, sexual reproduction actually as an exceptional one.”) NL.} 182. that at bottom . . . female] {Cf. Rolph, *Biologische Probleme*, 159: “Aus meiner Auffassung geht also hervor, dass ich die Männchen theoretisch als eine durch mindere Ernährung hervorgebrachte Form von Weibchen betrachte” (“Hence it follows from my interpretation that I regard the males theoretically as a form of females produced by insufficient nourishment”).} 183. origin... origin] Entstehung . . . Entstehung 184. that all organs . . . what is there.] {Cf. Karl Semper, *Die natürlichen Existenzbedingungen der Thiere* (“Animals natural conditions of existence”) (Leipzig: Brockhaus, 1880), vol. 1, esp. 18-19. NL.} 185. {Cf. BGE 264.} 186. Cf. BGE 209; 35[43]. 187. {WP 109.} 188. master] {Wagner liked to be called “Meister.”} 189. {WP 540.} 190. Cf. 34[181]; BGE 295. 191. “stupid to the point of sanctity] {Cf. Ivan Turgenev, “Sonderlinge,” trans. Wilhelm Lange, in *Vom fels zum Meer: Spemanns's Illustrierte Zeitschrift für das Deutsche Haus*, vol. 1, October 1881 through March 1882 (Stuttgart: Spemann, 1881), 235.} 192. Cf. BGE 228. 193. *neminem ... juva*] “Harm no one, rather help everyone to the extent that you can” (cf. BGE 186; the Latin phrase is from Arthur Schopenhauer, *The Two Fundamental Problems of Ethics*, trans. and ed. Christopher Janaway (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2009), 140.) [Page 436] NOTES TO PAGES 70-77 429 194. “*prithee*”] “*Bitte*” {*Bitte* means a request but is also the word used to say “please”; *beten* = to pray; *Gebet* = prayer; *bitten* = to request.} 195. “*sent*”] *Schicksal* = “fate”; *geschickt* = “sent” 196. right and righteousness] *Recht und Gerechtigkeit* 197. *causae efficientes*] “efficient causes” 198. *causae finales*] “final causes” 199. “Cognition”] “Erkennen” 200. know] *wissen* 201. Tarpeian Rock’] {The Tarpeian Rock is a cliff on the Capitoline Hill of Rome, from which criminals were hurled to their death.} 202. {Cf. Honoré Gabriel Riquetti, comte de Mirabeau, *Oeuvres de Mirabeau*, vol. 8: *Discours et opinions*, bk. 2 (Paris: Brissot-Thivars, 1825), 186: “Je navais pas besoin de cette leçon pour savoir qu il est peu de distance du Capitole à la roche Tarpéienne” (“I did not need this lesson to know that it is a

short distance from the Capitol to the Tarpeian Rock”).} 203. “discern”... know] “erkennen” . . . wissen 204. made-up] erdichteten, i.e., fictionalized, made up 205. Our... error] {Cf. Drossbach, Ueber die scheinbaren und die wirklichen Ursachen des Geschehens in der Welt, 10.} 206. Cf. 34[182]. 207. acting] wirkende 208. {Cf WP 493.} 209. Fragment about Richard Wagner. 210. Thoughts on BT, UO, HAH, Z. 211. {This and the following two fragments were written by N on a letter he received from Paul Lanzky, dated 1 June 1885, KGB III:4, 28.} 212. Cf. 34[256]. 213. {In the Nachbericht to KGW VII, 4/2, 70-73, thirteen additional fragments (34[260—272]) are added to Notebook 34 that do not appear in KSA. Parts of two of these, 34[260] and 34[264], were included in WP} 214. the two... ideals] {WP 1061. 215. contradictio (in adjecto)] “contradiction in terms” [Page 437] 430 NOTES TO PAGES 77—92 216. By morality... being] {WP 256.} 217. The criterion... power] {WP 534.} 218. niaiserie allemande] “German silliness” {Cf. note 89 above} [35 = W I 3a] i Cf. BGE 224. 2. {Cf. BGE 229.} 3. knowing] Wissen 4. Thoughts and Dashes] Gedanken und Gedankenstriche] {Literally, “thoughts and thought dashes” — N’s favorite punctuation mark is the dash, used to break off a thought for aposiopetic effect, similar to his use of ellipsis. Cf. the conclusion of 35[7] above.} 5. {WP 132.} 6. “Socialism”] N’s English. 7. disciplina voluntatis] “discipline of the will” 8. {WP 956; cf. BGE 200.} 9. Cf. 35[8, 9]. 10. 1. organic... assimilating etc.] {Cf. WP 658.} u. {Cf WP 967.3 Numbered according to CW, s[so]. 12. Cf. BGE 205. 13. {Cf. BGE 212.} 14. indifferentism] N’s English. 15. Cf. 34[182]; CW 14, 24[248]. 16. {Cf. WP 899.} 17. {Cf. WP 899.} 18. {WP 263.} 19. {Cf. WP 424.} 20. arrangement] N’s French. 21. {Cf WP 424} 22. Numbered according to CW, 5[so]. 23. “equal rights”... equal demands’) {Cf. William Henry Rolph, Biologische Probleme: Zugleich als Versuch einer rationellen Ethik, 2nd ed. (“Biological problems: At the same time an attempt at a rational ethics”) (Leipzig: Engelmann, 1884), 27: “Diese Ansicht aber ist eine Irrlehre, denn statt des Satzes: Gleiches [Page 438] NOTES TO PAGES 92-94 431 Recht für Alle, substituiert sie jenen anderen: Gleichen Anspruch für Alle.” (“But this view is a false doctrine, for instead of the proposition: Equal rights for all, it substitutes that other: Equal demands for all.” This sentence underlined by N. NL.} 24. cant] N’s English. 25. comfort] N’s English. 26. fashion] N’s English. 27. N refers here to Eduard von Hartmann, Phänomenologie des sittlichen Bewusstseins: Prolegomena zu jeder zukünftigen Ethik (“Phenomenology of ethical consciousness: Prolegomena to any future ethics”) (Berlin: C. Duncker, 1879). NL. 28. Added according to Peter Gast: Über den Ursprung der moralischen Empfindungen (Chemnitz: Schmeitzner, 1877). NL. {Paul Rée, The Origin of the Moral Sensations, trans. and ed. by Robin Small in Paul Rée, Basic Writings (Urbana: University of Illinois Press, 2003.} 29. {Cf. Stendhal, Correspondance inédite: Précédée d’une introduction

par Prosper Mérimée (“Unpublished correspondence: Preceded with an introduction by Prosper Mérimée”) (Paris: Michel Lévy Frères, 1855), 2:87: “Pour être bon philosophe, il faut être sec, clair, sans illusion.” (“To be a good philosopher, one must be dry, clear, without illusion.”) 30. Cf. Jean-Marie Guyau, *Esquisse d’une morale sans obligation ni sanction* (“Outline of a morality without obligation or penalty”) (Paris: Alcan, 1885). NL. 31. “petits faits”] “little facts” 32.

Appendix C

The Will to Power

Translated by Walter Kaufmann & R.J. Hollingdale

Book One — Two: (Part 1)

2 (Spring-Fall 1887)¹ What does nihilism mean? That the highest values devalue themselves. The aim is lacking; “why?” finds no answer. 3 (Spring-Fall 1887)² Radical nihilism is the conviction of an absolute untenability of existence when it comes to the highest values one recognizes; plus the realization that we lack the least right to posit a beyond or an in-itself of things that might be “divine” or morality incarnate. This realization is a consequence of the cultivation of “truthfulness”—thus itself a consequence of the faith in morality. 4 (June 10, 1887)³ What were the advantages of the Christian moral hypothesis? It granted man an absolute value, as opposed to his smallness and accidental occurrence in the flux of becoming and passing away. It served the advocates of God insofar as it conceded to the world, in spite of suffering and evil, the character of perfection—including “freedom”: evil appeared full of meaning. It posited that man had a knowledge of absolute values and thus adequate knowledge precisely regarding what is most important. It prevented man from despising himself as man, from taking sides against life; from despairing of knowledge: it was a means of preservation. In sum: morality was the great antidote against practical and theoretical nihilism. 5 (June 10, 1887)⁴ But among the forces cultivated by morality was truthfulness: this eventually turned against morality, discovered its teleology, its partial perspective—and now the recognition of this inveterate mendaciousness that one despairs of shedding becomes a stimulant. Now we discover in ourselves needs implanted by centuries of moral interpretation—needs that now appear to us as needs for untruth; on the other hand, the value for which we endure life seems to hinge on these needs. This antagonism—not to esteem what we know, and not to be allowed any longer to esteem the lies we should like to tell ourselves—results in a process of dissolution.

6 (Spring-Fall 1887)

This is the antinomy: Insofar as we believe in morality we pass sentence on existence.

7 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The supreme values in whose service man should live, especially when they were very hard on him and exacted a high price—these social values were erected over man to strengthen their voice, as if they were commands of God, as “reality,” as the “true” world, as a hope and future world. Now that the shabby origin of these values is becoming clear, the universe seems to have lost value, seems “meaningless”—but that is only a transitional stage. 8 (1883-1888) The nihilistic consequence (the belief in valuelessness) as a consequence of moral valuation: everything egoistic has come to disgust us (even though we realize the impossibility of the un-egoistic); what is necessary has come to disgust us (even though we realize the impossibility of any liberum arbitrium or “intelligible freedom”). We see that we cannot reach the sphere in which we have placed our values; but this does not by any means confer any value on that other sphere in which we live: on the contrary, we are weary because we have lost the main stimulus. “In vain so far!”

9 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Pessimism as a preliminary form of nihilism.

10 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Pessimism as strength—in what? in the energy of its logic, as anarchism and nihilism, as analytic. Pessimism as decline—in what? as growing effeteness, as a sort of cosmopolitan fingering, as “tout comprendre”⁶ and historicism. The critical tension: the extremes appear and become predominant.

11 (Spring-Fall 1887, rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

The logic of pessimism down to ultimate nihilism: what is at work in it? The idea of valuelessness, meaninglessness: to what extent moral valuations hide behind all other high values. Conclusion: Moral value judgments are ways of passing sentence, negations; morality is a way of turning one's back on the will to existence. Problem: But what is morality?

12 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Decline of Cosmological Values (A) Nihilism as a psychological state will have to be reached, first, when we have sought a “meaning” in all events that is not there: so the seeker eventually becomes discouraged. Nihilism, then, is the recognition of the long waste of strength, the agony of the “in vain,” insecurity, the lack of any opportunity to recover and to regain composure—being ashamed in front of oneself, as if one had deceived oneself all too long.— This meaning could have been: the “fulfillment” of some highest ethical canon in all events, the moral world order; or the growth of love and harmony in the intercourse of beings; or the gradual approximation of a state of universal happiness; or even the development toward a state of universal annihilation—any goal at least constitutes some meaning. What all these notions have in common is that something is to be achieved through the process—and now one realizes that becoming aims at nothing and achieves nothing.— Thus, disappointment regarding an alleged aim of becoming as a cause of nihilism: whether regarding a specific aim or, universalized, the realization that all previous hypotheses about aims that concern the whole “evolution” are inadequate (man no longer the collaborator, let alone the center, of becoming). Nihilism as a psychological state is reached, secondly, when one has posited a totality, a systematization, indeed any organization in all events, and underneath all events, and a soul that longs to admire and revere has wallowed in the idea of some supreme form of domination and administration (—if the soul be that of a logician, complete consistency and real dialectic are quite sufficient to reconcile it to everything). Some sort of unity, some form of “monism”: this faith suffices to give man a deep feeling of standing in the context of, and being dependent on, some whole that is infinitely superior to him, and he sees himself as a mode of the deity.— “The well-being of the universal demands the devotion of the individual”—but behold, there is no such universal! At bottom, man has lost the faith in his own value when no infinitely valuable whole works through him; i.e., he conceived such a whole in order to be able to believe in his own value. Nihilism as psychological state has yet a third and last form. Given these two insights, that becoming has no goal and that underneath all becoming there is no grand unity in which the individual could immerse himself completely as in an element of supreme value, an escape remains: to pass sentence on this whole world of becoming as a deception and to invent a world beyond it, a true world. But as soon as man finds out how that world is fabricated solely from psychological needs, and how he has absolutely no right to it, the last form of nihilism comes into being: it includes disbelief in any metaphysical world and forbids itself any belief in a true world.⁷ Having reached this standpoint, one grants the reality of becoming as the only reality, forbids oneself every kind of clandestine access to afterworlds and false

divinities—but cannot endure this world though one does not want to deny it. What has happened, at bottom? The feeling of valuelessness was reached with the realization that the overall character of existence may not be interpreted by means of the concept of “aim,” the concept of “unity,” or the concept of “truth.” Existence has no goal or end; any comprehensive unity in the plurality of events is lacking: the character of existence is not “true,” is false. One simply lacks any reason for convincing oneself that there is a true world. Briefly: the categories “aim,” “unity,” “being” which we used to project some value into the world—we pull out again; so the world looks valueless. (B) Suppose we realize how the world may no longer be interpreted in terms of these three categories, and that the world begins to become valueless for us after this insight: then we have to ask about the sources of our faith in these three categories. Let us try if it is not possible to give up our faith in them. Once we have devaluated these three categories, the demonstration that they cannot be applied to the universe is no longer any reason for devaluating the universe. Conclusion: The faith in the categories of reason is the cause of nihilism. We have measured the value of the world according to categories that refer to a purely fictitious world. Final conclusion: All the values by means of which we have tried so far to render the world estimable for ourselves and which then proved inapplicable and therefore devaluated the world—all these values are, psychologically considered, the results of certain perspectives of utility, designed to maintain and increase human constructs of domination—and they have been falsely projected into the essence of things. What we find here is still the hyperbolic naiveté of man: positing himself as the meaning and measure of the value of things. 13 (Spring-Fall 1887)⁸ Nihilism represents a pathological transitional stage (what is pathological is the tremendous generalization, the inference that there is no meaning at all): whether the productive forces are not yet strong enough, or whether decadence still hesitates and has not yet invented its remedies. Presupposition of this hypothesis: that there is no truth, that there is no absolute nature of things nor a “thing-in-itself.” This, too, is merely nihilism—even the most extreme nihilism. It places the value of things precisely in the lack of any reality corresponding to these values and in their being merely a symptom of strength on the part of the value-posers, a simplification for the sake of life.

14 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Values and their changes are related to increases in the power of those positing the values. The measure of unbelief, of permitted “freedom of the spirit” as an expression of an increase in power. “Nihilism” an ideal of the highest degree of powerfulness of the spirit, the over-richest life—partly destructive, partly ironic.

15 (Spring-Fall 1887)

What is a belief? How does it originate? Every belief is a considering-something-true. The most extreme form of nihilism would be the view that every belief, every considering-something-true, is necessarily false because there simply is no true world. Thus: a perspectival appearance whose origin lies in us (in so far as we continually need a narrower, abbreviated, simplified world). —That it is the measure of strength to what extent we can admit to ourselves, without perishing, the merely apparent character, the necessity of lies. To this extent, nihilism, as the denial of a truthful world, of being, might be a divine way of thinking.

16 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

If we are “disappointed,” it is at least not regarding life: rather we are now facing up to all kinds of “desiderata.” With scornful wrath we contemplate what are called “ideals”; we despise ourselves only because there are moments when we cannot subdue that absurd impulse that is called “idealism.” The influence of too much coddling is stronger than the wrath of the disappointed.

17 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. 1888)

To what extent Schopenhauer's nihilism still follows from the same ideal that created Christian theism.— One felt so certain about the highest desiderata, the highest values, the highest perfection that the philosophers assumed this as an absolute certainty, as if it were a priori: "God" at the apex as a given truth. "To become as God," "to be absorbed into God"—for thousands of years these were the most naive and convincing desiderata (but what convinces is not necessarily true—it is merely convincing; a note for asses). One has unlearned the habit of conceding to this posited ideal the reality of a person; one has become atheistic. But has the ideal itself been renounced?— At bottom, the last metaphysicians still seek in it true "reality," the "thing-in-itself" compared to which everything else is merely apparent. It is their dogma that our apparent world, being so plainly not the expression of this ideal, cannot be "true"—and that, at bottom, it does not even lead us back to that metaphysical world as its cause. The unconditional, representing that highest perfection, cannot possibly be the ground of all that is conditional. Schopenhauer wanted it otherwise and therefore had to conceive of this metaphysical ground as the opposite of the ideal—as "evil, blind will": that way it could be that "which appears," that which reveals itself in the world of appearances. But even so he did not renounce the absoluteness of the ideal—he sneaked by.— (Kant considered the hypothesis of "intelligible freedom" necessary in order to acquit the *ens perfectum* of responsibility for the world's being such-and-such—in short, to account for evil and ills: a scandalous bit of logic for a philosopher.—) 18 (1883-1888) The most universal sign of the modern age: man has lost dignity in his own eyes to an incredible extent. For a long time the center and tragic hero of existence in general; then at least intent on proving himself closely related to the decisive and essentially valuable side of existence—like all metaphysicians who wish to cling to the dignity of man, with their faith that moral values are cardinal values. Those who have abandoned God cling that much more firmly to the faith in morality.¹⁰ 19 (1883-1888) Every purely moral value system (that of Buddhism, for example) ends in nihilism: this to be expected in Europe. One still hopes to get along with a moralism without religious background: but that necessarily leads to nihilism.— In religion the constraint is lacking to consider ourselves as value-positing.

20 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The nihilistic question “for what?” is rooted in the old habit of supposing that the goal must be put up, given, demanded from outside—by some superhuman authority. Having unlearned faith in that, one still follows the old habit and seeks another authority that can speak unconditionally and command goals and tasks. The authority of conscience now steps up front (the more emancipated one is from theology, the more imperativistic morality becomes) to compensate for the loss of a personal authority. Or the authority of reason. Or the social instinct (the herd). Or history with an immanent spirit and a goal within, so one can entrust oneself to it. One wants to get around the will, the willing of a goal, the risk of positing a goal for oneself; one wants to rid oneself of the responsibility (one would accept fatalism). Finally, happiness—and, with a touch of Tartuffe, the happiness of the greatest number. One says to oneself: a definite goal is not necessary at all, cannot possibly be anticipated. Just now when the greatest strength of will would be necessary, it is weakest and least confident. Absolute mistrust regarding the organizing strength of the will for the whole.¹¹

21 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. 1888)

The perfect nihilist.— The nihilist's eye idealizes in the direction of ugliness and is unfaithful to his memories: it allows them to drop, lose their leaves; it does not guard them against the corpse-like pallor that weakness pours out over what is distant and gone. And what he does not do for himself, he also does not do for the whole past of mankind: he lets it drop. 22 (Spring-Fall 1887)¹² Nihilism. It is ambiguous: A. Nihilism as a sign of increased power of the spirit: as active nihilism. B. Nihilism as decline and recession of the power of the spirit: as passive nihilism. 23 (Spring-Fall 1887)¹³ Nihilism as a normal condition. It can be a sign of strength: the spirit may have grown so strong that previous goals ("convictions," articles of faith) have become incommensurate (for a faith generally expresses the constraint of conditions of existence, submission to the authority of circumstances under which one flourishes, grows, gains power). Or a sign of the lack of strength to posit for oneself, productively, a goal, a why, a faith. It reaches its maximum of relative strength as a violent force of destruction—as active nihilism. Its opposite: the weary nihilism that no longer attacks; its most famous form, Buddhism; a passive nihilism, a sign of weakness. The strength of the spirit may be worn out, exhausted, so that previous goals and values have become incommensurate and no longer are believed; so that the synthesis of values and goals (on which every strong culture rests) dissolves and the individual values war against each other: disintegration—and whatever refreshes, heals, calms, numbs emerges into the foreground in various disguises, religious or moral, or political, or aesthetic, etc.

24 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Nihilism does not only contemplate the “in vain!” nor is it merely the belief that everything deserves to perish: one helps to destroy.— This is, if you will, illogical; but the nihilist does not believe that one needs to be logical.— It is the condition of strong spirits and wills, and these do not find it possible to stop with the No of “judgment”: their nature demands the No of the deed. The reduction to nothing by judgment is seconded by the reduction to nothing by hand.

25 (Spring-Fall 1887)

On the genesis of the nihilist.— It is only late that one musters the courage for what one really knows.¹⁴ That I have hitherto been a thorough-going nihilist, I have admitted to myself only recently: the energy and radicalism with which I advanced as a nihilist deceived me about this basic fact. When one moves toward a goal it seems impossible that “goal-lessness as such” is the principle of our faith.

26 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The pessimism of active energy: the question “for what?” after a terrible struggle, even victory. That something is a hundred times more important than the question of whether we feel well or not: basic instinct of all strong natures—and consequently also whether others feel well or not. In sum, that we have a goal for which one does not hesitate to offer human sacrifices, to risk every danger, to take upon oneself whatever is bad and worst: the great passion.

27 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Causes of nihilism: 1. The higher species is lacking, i.e., those whose inexhaustible fertility and power keep up the faith in man. (One should recall what one owes to Napoleon: almost all of the higher hopes of this century.) All attempts to think up higher types failed (“romanticism”; the artist, the philosopher; against Carlyle’s attempt to ascribe to them the highest moral values). The resistance to higher types as a result. Decline and insecurity of all higher types. The fight against the genius (“folk poetry,” etc.). Pity for the lowly and suffering as a measure for the height of a soul. The philosopher is lacking who interprets the deed and does not merely transpose it.

28 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Main proposition. How complete nihilism is the necessary consequence of the ideals entertained hitherto.¹⁵ Incomplete nihilism; its forms: we live in the midst of it. Attempts to escape nihilism without reevaluating our values so far: they produce the opposite, make the problem more acute. 29 (1883-1888) The ways of self-narcotization.—¹⁶ Deep down: not knowing whither. Emptiness. Attempt to get over it by intoxication: intoxication as music; intoxication as cruelty in the tragic enjoyment of the destruction of the noblest; intoxication as blind enthusiasm for single human beings or ages (as hatred, etc.).— Attempt to work blindly as an instrument of science: opening one's eyes to the many small enjoyments; e.g., also in the quest of knowledge (modesty toward oneself); resignation to generalizing about oneself, a pathos; mysticism, the voluptuous enjoyment of eternal emptiness; art "for its own sake" ("le fait") and "pure knowledge" as narcotic states of disgust with oneself; some kind or other of continual work, or of some stupid little fanaticism; a medley of all means, sickness owing to general immoderation (debauchery kills enjoyment). Weakness of the will as a result. Extreme pride and the humiliation of petty weakness felt in contrast.

30 (Nov. 1887-March 1888; rev. 1888)

The time has come when we have to pay for having been Christians for two thousand years: we are losing the center of gravity by virtue of which we lived; we are lost for a while. Abruptly we plunge into the opposite valuations, with all the energy that such an extreme overvaluation of man has generated in man. Now everything is false through and through, mere “words chaotic, weak, or extravagant: a. one attempts a kind of this-worldly solution, but in the same sense—that of the eventual triumph of truth, love, and justice (socialism: “equality of the person”); b. one also tries to hold on to the moral ideal (with the pre-eminence of what is un-egoistic, self-denial, negation of the will); c. one tries to hold on even to the “beyond”—even if only as some antilogical “x”—but one immediately interprets it in such a way that some sort of old-fashioned metaphysical comfort can be derived from it; d. one tries to find in events an old-fashioned divine governance—an order of things that rewards, punishes, educates, and betters; e. one still believes in good and evil and experiences the triumph of the good and the annihilation of evil as a task (that is English; typical case: the flathead John Stuart Mill); f. contempt for what is “natural,” for desire, for the ego: attempt to understand even the highest spirituality and art as the consequence of depersonalization and as *désintéressement*; g. the church is still permitted to obtrude into all important experiences and main points of individual life to hallow them and give them a higher meaning: we still have the “Christian state,” “Christian marriage”—17 31 (1884) There have been more thoughtful and thought-addicted ages than ours: ages, e.g., like that in which the Buddha appeared, when after centuries of quarrels among sects the people themselves were as deeply lost in the ravines of philosophic doctrines as European nations were at times in the subtleties of religious dogmas. Surely, one should not let “literature” and the press seduce us to think well of the “spirit” of our time: the existence of millions of spiritists and a Christianity that goes in for gymnastics of that gruesome ugliness that characterizes all English inventions are more instructive. European pessimism is still in its early stages—bears witness against itself: it still lacks that tremendous, yearning rigidity of expression in which the Nothing is reflected, once found in India; it is still far too contrived and too little “organic”—too much a pessimism of scholars and poets: I mean, much of it is excogitated and invented, is “created” and not a “cause.”

32 (Summer-Fall 1888)

Critique of pessimism to date.— Resistance to eudaemonistic considerations as the last reduction to the question: what does it mean? The reduction of growing gloom.— Our pessimism: the world does not have the value we thought it had. Our faith itself has so increased our desire for knowledge that today we have to say this. Initial result: it seems worth less; that is how it is experienced initially. It is only in this sense that we are pessimists; i.e., in our determination to admit this revaluation to ourselves without any reservation, and to stop telling ourselves tales—lies—the old way. That is precisely how we find the pathos that impels us to seek new values. In sum: the world might be far more valuable than we used to believe; we must see through the naïveté of our ideals, and while we thought that we accorded it the highest interpretation, we may not even have given our human existence a moderately fair value. What has been deified? The value instincts in the community (that which made possible its continued existence). What has been slandered? That which set apart the higher men from the lower, the desires that create clefts.

33 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Causes of the advent of pessimism: that the most powerful desires of life that have the most future have hitherto been slandered, so a curse weighs on life; that the growing courage and integrity and the bolder mistrust that now characterize man comprehend that these instincts are inseparable from life, and one therefore turns against life; that only the most mediocre, who have no feeling at all for this conflict, flourish while the higher kind miscarries and, as a product of degeneration, invites antipathy—that the mediocre, on the other hand, when they pose as the goal and meaning, arouse indignation (that nobody is able any more to answer any “for what?”); that diminution, sensitivity to pain, restlessness, haste, and hustling grow continually—that it becomes easier and easier to recognize this whole commotion, this so-called “civilization,” and that the individual, faced with this tremendous machinery, loses courage and submits. 34 (1835-1886) Modern pessimism is an expression of the uselessness of the modern world—not of the world of existence.

35 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The “predominance of suffering over pleasure” or the opposite (hedonism): these two doctrines are already signposts to nihilism. For in both of these cases no ultimate meaning is posited except the appearance of pleasure or displeasure. But that is how a kind of man speaks that no longer dares to posit a will, a purpose, a meaning: for any healthier kind of man the value of life is certainly not measured by the standard of these trifles. And suffering might predominate, and in spite of that a powerful will might exist, a Yes to life, a need for this predominance. “Life is not worthwhile”; “resignation”; “why the tears?”—a weakly and sentimental way of thinking. “Un monstre gai vaut mieux qu’un sentimental ennuyeux”¹⁸

36 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The philosophical nihilist is convinced that all that happens is meaningless and in vain; and that there ought not to be anything meaningless and in vain. But whence this: there ought not to be? From where does one get this “meaning,” this standard?—At bottom, the nihilist thinks that the sight of such a bleak, useless existence makes a philosopher feel dissatisfied, bleak, desperate. Such an insight goes against our finer sensibility as philosophers. It amounts to the absurd valuation: to have any right to be, the character of existence would have to give the philosopher pleasure.— Now it is easy to see that pleasure and displeasure can only be means in the course of events: the question remains whether we are at all able to see the “meaning,” the “aim,” whether the question of meaninglessness or its opposite is not insoluble for us.—

37 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The development of pessimism into nihilism.— Denaturalization of values. Scholasticism of values. Detached and idealistic, values, instead of dominating and guiding action, turn against action and condemn it. Opposites replace natural degrees and ranks. Hatred against the order of rank. Opposites suit a plebeian age because easier to comprehend. The repudiated world versus an artificially built “true, valuable” one.— Finally: one discovers of what material one has built the “true world”: and now all one has left is the repudiated world, and one adds this supreme disappointment to the reasons why it deserves to be repudiated. At this point nihilism is reached: all one has left are the values that pass judgment— nothing else. Here the problem of strength and weakness originates: The weak perish of it; those who are stronger destroy what does not perish; those who are strongest overcome the values that pass judgment. In sum this constitutes the tragic age. 38 (1883-1888) Recently much mischief has been done with an accidental and in every way unsuitable word: everywhere “pessimism” is discussed, and the question is debated whether pessimism or optimism is right, as if there must be answers to that. One fails to see, although it could hardly be more obvious, that pessimism is not a problem but a symptom, that the name should be replaced by “nihilism,” that the question whether not-to-be is better than to be is itself a disease, a sign of decline, an idiosyncrasy. The nihilistic movement is merely the expression of physiological decadence.

39 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

To be comprehended: That every kind of decay and sickness has continually helped to form overall value judgments; that decadence has actually gained predominance in the value judgments that have become accepted; that we not only have to fight against the consequences of all present misery of degeneration, but that all previous decadence is still residual, i.e., survives. Such a total aberration of mankind from its basic instincts, such a total decadence of value judgments—that is the question mark par excellence, the real riddle that the animal “man” poses for the philosopher.

40 (March-June 1888)

The concept of decadence.— Waste, decay, elimination need not be condemned: they are necessary consequences of life, of the growth of life. The phenomenon of decadence is as necessary as any increase and advance of life: one is in no position to abolish it. Reason demands, on the contrary, that we do justice to it. It is a disgrace for all socialist systematizers that they suppose there could be circumstances—social combinations—in which vice, disease, prostitution, distress would no longer grow.— But that means condemning life.— A society is not free to remain young. And even at the height of its strength it has to form refuse and waste materials. The more energetically and boldly it advances, the richer it will be in failures and deformities, the closer to decline.— Age is not abolished by means of institutions. Neither is disease. Nor vice.

41 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Basic insight regarding the nature of decadence: its supposed causes are its consequences. This changes the whole perspective of moral problems. The whole moral struggle against vice, luxury, crime, even disease, appears a naïveté and superfluous: there is no “improvement” (against repentance). Decadence itself is nothing to be fought: it is absolutely necessary and belongs to every age and every people. What should be fought vigorously is the contagion of the healthy parts of the organism. Is this being done? The opposite is done. Precisely that is attempted in the name of humanity. —How are the supreme values held so far, related to this basic biological question? Philosophy, religion, morality, art, etc. (The cure: eg., militarism, beginning with Napoleon who considered civilization his natural enemy.)¹⁹

42 (March-June 1888)

First principle: The supposed causes of degeneration are its consequences. But the supposed remedies of degeneration are also mere palliatives against some of its effects: the “cured” are merely one type of the degenerates. Consequences of decadence: vice—the addiction to vice; sickness—sickliness; crime—criminality; celibacy—sterility; hystericism—weakness of the will; alcoholism; pessimism; anarchism; libertinism (also of the spirit). The slanderers, underminers, doubters, destroyers.

43 (March-June 1888)

On the concept of decadence. Skepticism is a consequence of decadence, as is libertinism of the spirit. The corruption of morals is a consequence of decadence (weakness of the will, need for strong stimuli). Attempted cures, psychological and moral, do not change the course of decadence, do not arrest it, are physiologically naught: Insight into the great nullity of these presumptuous “reactions”; they are forms of narcotization against certain terrible consequences; they do not eliminate the morbid element; often they are heroic attempts to annul the man of decadence and to realize the minimum of his harmfulness. Nihilism is no cause but merely the logical result of decadence. The “good” and “bad” man are merely two types of decadence: in all basic phenomena they agree. The social question is a consequence of decadence. Sickesses, especially those affecting nerves and head, are signs that the defensive strength of the strong natures is lacking; precisely this is suggested by irritability, so pleasure and displeasure become foreground problems. 44 (Spring-Summer 1888)²⁰ Most general types of decadence: Believing one chooses remedies, one chooses in fact that which hastens exhaustion; Christianity is an example (to name the greatest example of such an aberration of the instincts); “progress” is another instance.— One loses one’s power of resistance against stimuli—and comes to be at the mercy of accidents: one coarsens and enlarges one’s experiences tremendously —“depersonalization,” disintegration of the will; example: one whole type of morality, the altruistic one which talks much of pity—and is distinguished by the weakness of the personality, so that it is sounded, too,²¹ and like an over-stimulated string vibrates continually—an extreme irritability.— One confuses cause and effect: one fails to understand decadence as a physiological condition and mistakes its consequences for the real cause of the indisposition; example: all of religious morality.— One longs for a condition in which one no longer suffers: life is actually experienced as the ground of ills; one esteems unconscious states, without feeling, (sleep, fainting) as incomparably more valuable than conscious ones;²² from this a method—

45 (March-June 1888)

On the hygiene of the “weak.”— Everything done in weakness fails. Moral: do nothing. Only there is the hitch that precisely the strength to suspend activity, not to react, is sickest of all under the influence of weakness: one never reacts more quickly and blindly than when one should not react at all.— A strong nature manifests itself by waiting and postponing any reaction:²³ it is as much characterized by a certain adiaphoria as weakness is by an involuntary countermovement and the suddenness and inevitability of “action.”— The will is weak— and the prescription to avoid stupidities would be to have a strong will and to do nothing.— Contradictio.— A kind of self-destruction; the instinct of preservation is compromised.— The weak harm themselves.— That is the type of decadence.— In fact, we find a tremendous amount of reflection about practices that would lead to impassability. The instinct is on the right track insofar as doing nothing is more expedient than doing something — All the practices of the orders, the solitary philosophers, the fakirs are inspired by the right value standard that a certain kind of man cannot benefit himself more than by preventing himself as much as possible from acting.— Means of relief: absolute obedience, machinelike activity, avoidance of people and things that would demand instant decisions and actions.

46 (March-June 1888)

Weakness of the will: that is a metaphor that can prove misleading. For there is no will, and consequently neither a strong nor a weak will.²⁵ The multitude and disgregation of impulses and the lack of any systematic order among them result in a “weak will”; their coordination under a single predominant impulse results in a “strong will”: in the first case it is the oscillation and the lack of gravity; in the latter, the precision and clarity of the direction.

47 (March-June 1888)

What is inherited is not the sickness but sickliness: the lack of strength to resist the danger of infections, etc., the broken resistance; morally speaking, resignation and meekness in face of the enemy. I have asked myself if all the supreme values of previous philosophy, morality, and religion could not be compared to the values of the weakened, the mentally ill, and neurasthenics: in a milder form, they represent the same ills.— It is the value of all morbid states that they show us under a magnifying glass certain states that are normal—but not easily visible when normal.— Health and sickness are not essentially different, as the ancient physicians and some practitioners even today suppose. One must not make of them distinct principles or entities that fight over the living organism and turn it into their arena. That is silly nonsense and chatter that is no good any longer. In fact, there are only differences in degree between these two kinds of existence: the exaggeration, the disproportion, the nonharmony of the normal phenomena constitute the pathological state (Claude Bernard). Just as “evil” can be considered as exaggeration, disharmony, disproportion, “the good” may be a protective diet against the danger of exaggeration, disharmony, and disproportion. Hereditary weakness as the dominant feeling: cause of the supreme values. N.B. One wants weakness: why? Usually because one is necessarily weak. —Weakness as a task: weakening the desires, the feelings of pleasure and displeasure, the will to power, to a sense of pride, to want to have and have more; weakening as meekness; weakening as faith; weakening as aversion and shame in the face of everything natural, as negation of life, as sickness and habitual weakness—weakening as the renunciation of revenge, of resistance, of enmity and wrath. The error in treatment: one does not want to fight weakness with a *système fortifiant*,²⁶ but rather with a kind of justification and moralization; i.e., with an interpretation.— —Two totally different states confounded: e.g., the calm of strength, which is essentially forbearance from reaction (type of the gods whom nothing moves)—and the calm of exhaustion, rigidity to the point of anesthesia. All philosophic-ascetic procedures aim at the second, but really intend the former—for they attribute predicates to the attained state as if a divine state had been attained.

48 (March-June 1888)

The most dangerous misunderstanding.— One concept apparently permits no confusion or ambiguity: that of exhaustion. Exhaustion can be acquired or inherited—in any case it changes the aspect of things, the value of things.— As opposed to those who, from the fullness they represent and feel, involuntarily give to things and see them fuller, more powerful, and pregnant with future—who at least are able to bestow something—the exhausted diminish and botch all they see—they impoverish the value: they are harmful.— About this no mistake seems possible: yet history contains the gruesome fact that the exhausted have always been mistaken for the fullest—and the fullest for the most harmful. Those poor in life, the weak, impoverish life; those rich in life, the strong, enrich it. The first are parasites of life; the second give presents to it.— How is it possible to confound these two? When the exhausted appeared with the gesture of the highest activity and energy (when degeneration effected an excess of spiritual and nervous discharge), they were mistaken for the rich. They excited fear.— The cult of the fool is always the cult of those rich in life, the powerful. The fanatic, the possessed, the religious epileptic, all eccentrics have been experienced as the highest types of power: as divine. This kind of strength that excites fear was considered preeminently divine: here was the origin of authority; here one interpreted, heard, sought wisdom.— This led to the development, almost everywhere, of a will to “deify,” i.e., a will to the typical degeneration of spirit, body, and nerves: an attempt to find the way to this higher level of being. To make oneself sick, mad, to provoke the symptoms of derangement and ruin—that was taken for becoming stronger, more superhuman, more terrible, wiser.²⁷ One thought that in this way one became so rich in power that one could give from one’s fullness. Wherever one adored one sought one who could give. Here the experience of intoxication proved misleading. This increases the feeling of power in the highest degree—therefore, naively judged, power itself. On the highest rung of power one placed the most intoxicated, the ecstatic. (—There are two sources of intoxication: the over-great fullness of life and a state of pathological nourishment of the brain.)²⁸

49 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Acquired, not inherited, exhaustion: (1) Inadequate nourishment, often from ignorance about nourishment; e.g., among scholars. (2) Erotic precociousness: the curse in particular of French youth, above all in Paris, who emerge into the world from their lycées botched and soiled and never free themselves again from the chain of contemptible inclinations, ironical and disdainful toward themselves—galley slaves with all refinements (incidentally, in most cases already a symptom of the decadence of race and family, like all hypersensitivity; also the contagion of the milieu—to let oneself be determined by one's environment is decadent). (3) Alcoholism—not the instinct but the habit, the stupid imitation, the cowardly or vain assimilation to a dominant regime: What a blessing a Jew is among Germans! How much dullness, how blond the head, how blue the eye; the lack of esprit in face, word, posture; the lazy stretching-oneself, the German need for a good rest—not prompted by overwork but by the disgusting stimulation and overstimulation through alcoholica.— 50 (1888) Theory of exhaustion.— Vice, the mentally ill (resp., the artists—), the criminals, the anarchists—these are not the oppressed classes but the scum of previous society of all classes.— Realizing that all our classes are permeated by these elements, we understand that modern society is no “society,” no “body,” but a sick conglomerate of chandalas—a society that no longer has the strength to excrete. To what extent sickliness, owing to the symbiosis of centuries, goes much deeper:

51 (March-June 1888)

The state of corruption.— To understand how all forms of corruption belong together, without forgetting the Christian corruption (Pascal as type) as well as the socialist-communist corruption (a consequence of the Christian—from the point of view of the natural sciences, the socialists' conception of the highest society is the lowest in the order of rank); also the “beyond” corruption: as if outside the actual world, that of becoming, there were another world of being. Here no terms are permissible: here one has to eradicate, annihilate, wage war; everywhere the Christian-nihilistic value standard still has to be pulled up and fought under every mask; e.g., in present-day sociology, in present-day music, in present-day pessimism (all of them forms of the Christian value ideal). Either the one is true or the other: true here means elevating the type of man. The priest, the shepherd of souls, as objectionable forms of existence. All of education to date, helpless, untenable, without center of gravity, stained by the contradiction of values.

52 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Nature is not immoral when it has no pity for the degenerate: on the contrary, the growth of physiological and moral ills among mankind is the consequence of a pathological and unnatural morality. The sensibility of the majority of men is pathological and unnatural. Why is it that mankind is corrupt morally and physiologically?— The body perishes when an organ is altered. The right of altruism cannot be derived from physiology; nor can the right to help and to an equality of lots: these are prizes for the degenerate and underprivileged. There is no solidarity in a society in which there are sterile, unproductive, and destructive elements—which, incidentally, will have descendants even more degenerate than they are themselves.

53 (March-June 1888)

Even the ideals of science can be deeply, yet completely unconsciously influenced by decadence: our entire sociology is proof of that. The objection to it is that from experience it knows only the form of the decay of society, and inevitably it takes its own instincts of decay for the norms of sociological judgment. In these norms the life that is declining in present-day Europe formulates its social ideals: one cannot tell them from the ideals of old races that have outlived themselves.— The herd instinct, then—a power that has now become sovereign—is something totally different from the instinct of an aristocratic society: and the value of the units determines the significance of the sum.— Our entire sociology simply does not know any other instinct than that of the herd, i.e., that of the sum of zeroes—where every zero has “equal rights,” where it is virtuous to be zero.— The valuation that is today applied to the different forms of society is entirely identical with that which assigns a higher value to peace than to war: but this judgment is antibiological, is itself a fruit of the decadence of life.— Life is a consequence of war, society itself a means to war.— As a biologist, Mr. Herbert Spencer is a decadent; as a moralist, too (he considers the triumph of altruism a desideratum! ! !).29

54 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

It is my good fortune that after whole millennia of error and confusion I have rediscovered the way that leads to a Yes and a No. I teach the No to all that makes weak—that exhausts. I teach the Yes to all that strengthens, that stores up strength, that justifies the feeling of strength. So far one has taught neither the one nor the other: virtue has been taught, mortification of the self, pity, even the negation of life. All these are the values of the exhausted. Prolonged reflection on the physiology of exhaustion forced me to ask to what extent the judgments of the exhausted had penetrated the world of values. My result was as surprising as possible, even for me who was at home in many a strange world: I found that all of the supreme value judgments—all that have come to dominate mankind, at least that part that has become tame—can be derived from the judgments of the exhausted. Under the holiest names I pulled up destructive tendencies; one has called God what weakens, teaches weakness, infects with weakness.— I found that the “good man” is one of the forms in which decadence affirms itself. That virtue of which Schopenhauer still taught that it is the supreme, the only virtue, and the basis of all virtues—precisely pity I recognized as more dangerous than any vice. To cross as a matter of principle selection in the species and its purification of refuse—that has so far been called virtue par excellence.— One should respect fatality—that fatality that says to the weak: perish!— One has called it God—that one resisted fatality, that one corrupted mankind and made it rot.— One should not use the name of God in vain.— The race is corrupted—not by its vices but by its ignorance; it is corrupted because it did not recognize exhaustion as exhaustion: mistakes about physiological states are the source of all ills.— Virtue is our greatest misunderstanding. Problem: How did the exhausted come to make the laws about values? Put differently: How did those come to power who are the last?— How did the instinct of the human animal come to stand on its head?—30 55 (June 10, 1887)³¹ Extreme positions are not succeeded by moderate ones but by extreme positions of the opposite kind. Thus the belief in the absolute immorality of nature, in aim- and meaninglessness, is the psychologically necessary affect once the belief in God and an essentially moral order becomes untenable. Nihilism appears at that point, not that the displeasure at existence has become greater than before but because one has come to mistrust any “meaning” in suffering, indeed in existence. One interpretation has collapsed; but because it was considered the interpretation it now seems as if there were no meaning at all in existence, as if everything were in vain. * That this “in vain” constitutes the character of present-day nihilism remains to be shown. The mistrust of our previous valuations grows until it becomes the question: “Are not all ‘values’ lures that draw out the comedy without bringing it closer to a solution?” Duration “in vain,” without end or aim,

is the most paralyzing idea, particularly when one understands that one is being fooled and yet lacks the power not to be fooled. * Let us think this thought in its most terrible form: existence as it is, without meaning or aim, yet recurring inevitably without any finale of nothingness: “the eternal recurrence.”³² This is the most extreme form of nihilism: the nothing (the “meaningless”), eternally! The European form of Buddhism: the energy of knowledge and strength compels this belief. It is the most scientific of all possible hypotheses. We deny end goals: if existence had one it would have to have been reached. * So one understands that an antithesis to pantheism is attempted here: for “everything perfect, divine, eternal” also compels a faith in the “eternal recurrence.” Question: does morality make impossible this pantheistic affirmation of all things, too? At bottom, it is only the moral god that has been overcome. Does it make sense to conceive a god “beyond good and evil”? Would a pantheism in this sense be possible? Can we remove the idea of a goal from the process and then affirm the process in spite of this?— This would be the case if something were attained at every moment within this process—and always the same. Spinoza reached such an affirmative position in so far as every moment has a logical necessity, and with his basic instinct, which was logical, he felt a sense of triumph that the world should be constituted that way. * But his case is only a single case. Every basic character trait that is encountered at the bottom of every event, that finds expression in every event, would have to lead every individual who experienced it as his own basic character trait to welcome every moment of universal existence with a sense of triumph. The crucial point would be that one experienced this basic character trait in oneself as good, valuable—with pleasure. * It was morality that protected life against despair and the leap into nothing, among men and classes who were violated and oppressed by men: for it is the experience of being powerless against men, not against nature, that generates the most desperate embitterment against existence. Morality treated the violent despots, the doers of violence, the “masters” in general as the enemies against whom the common man must be protected, which means first of all encouraged and strengthened. Morality consequently taught men to hate and despise most profoundly what is the basic character trait of those who rule: their will to power. To abolish, deny, and dissolve this morality—that would mean looking at the best-hated drive with an opposite feeling and valuation. If the suffering and oppressed lost the faith that they have the right to despise the will to power, they would enter the phase of hopeless despair. This would be the case if this trait were essential to life and it could be shown that even in this will to morality this very “will to power” were hidden, and even this hatred and contempt were still a will to power. The oppressed would come to see that they were on the same plain with the oppressors, without prerogative, without higher rank. * Rather the opposite! There is nothing to life that has value, except the degree of power—

assuming that life itself is the will to power. Morality guarded the underprivileged against nihilism by assigning to each an infinite value, a metaphysical value, and by placing each in an order that did not agree with the worldly order of rank and power: it taught resignation, meekness, etc. Supposing that the faith in this morality would perish, then the underprivileged would no longer have their comfort—and they would perish. * This perishing takes the form of self-destruction—the instinctive selection of that which must destroy. Symptoms of this self-destruction of the underprivileged: self-vivisection, poisoning, intoxication, romanticism, above all the instinctive need for actions that turn the powerful into mortal enemies (as it were, one breeds one's own hangmen); the will to destruction as the will of a still deeper instinct, the instinct of self-destruction, the will for nothingness. * Nihilism as a symptom that the underprivileged have no comfort left; that they destroy in order to be destroyed; that without morality they no longer have any reason to “resign themselves”—that they place themselves on the plain of the opposite principle and also want power by compelling the powerful to become their hangmen. This is the European form of Buddhism—doing No after all existence has lost its “meaning.” * It is not that “distress” has grown: on the contrary. “God, morality, resignation,” were remedies on terribly low rungs of misery: active nihilism appears in relatively much more favorable conditions. The feeling that morality has been overcome presupposes a fair degree of spiritual culture, and this in turn that one is relatively well off. A certain spiritual weariness that, owing to the long fight of philosophical opinions, has reached the most hopeless skepticism regarding all philosophy, is another sign of the by no means low position of these nihilists. Consider the situation in which the Buddha appeared. The doctrine of the eternal recurrence would have scholarly presuppositions (as did the Buddha's doctrine; e.g., the concept of causality, etc.). * What does “underprivileged” mean? Above all, physiologically—no longer politically. The unhealthiest kind of man in Europe (in all classes) furnishes the soil for this nihilism: they will experience the belief in the eternal recurrence as a curse, struck by which one no longer shrinks from any action; not to be extinguished passively but to extinguish everything that is so aim- and meaningless, although this is a mere convulsion, a blind rage at the insight that everything has been for eternities—even this moment of nihilism and lust for destruction.—It is the value of such a crisis that it purifies, that it pushes together related elements to perish of each other, that it assigns common tasks to men who have opposite ways of thinking—and it also brings to light the weaker and less secure among them and thus promotes an order of rank according to strength, from the point of view of health: those who command are recognized as those who command, those who obey as those who obey. Of course, outside every existing social order. * Who will prove to be the strongest in the course of this? The most moderate; those who do not require any

extreme articles of faith; those who not only concede but love a fair amount of accidents and nonsense; those who can think of man with a considerable reduction of his value without becoming small and weak on that account: those richest in health who are equal to most misfortunes and therefore not so afraid of misfortunes—human beings who are sure of their power and represent the attained strength of humanity with conscious pride. * How would such a human being even think of the eternal recurrence?

56 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Periods of European Nihilism The period of unclarity, of all kinds of tentative men who would conserve the old without letting go of the new. The period of clarity: one understands that the old and the new are basically opposite, the old values born of declining and the new ones of ascending life—that all the old ideals are hostile to life (born of decadence and agents of decadence, even if in the magnificent Sunday clothes of morality). We understand the old and are far from strong enough for something new. The period of the three great affects: contempt, pity, destruction. The period of catastrophe: the advent of a doctrine that sifts men—driving the weak to decisions, and the strong as well— “Nihilism as a normal condition Nihilism: the aim is lacking; ‘why?’ finds no answer What does nihilism mean? That the highest values devalue themselves. “It is ambiguous: “A. Nihilism as a sign of increased power of the spirit: active nihilism. “It can be a sign of strength:...” (See Podach *Ein Blick in Notizbücher Nietzsches*, Heidelberg, Wolfgang Rothe, 1963, pp 205 f. In Schlechta’s edition the note appears in four parts, in the same sequence as in the standard editions: 2, 13, 22, and 23. For further discussion of Podach and Schlechta see Kaufmann, “Nietzsche in the Light of his Suppressed Manuscripts,” in *Journal of the History of Philosophy*, October 1964 (II 2), pp. 205-225. “with the same amount of energy with which we used to be Christians—with which the absurd exaggeration of the Christian...” This sentence breaks off, but a few other phrases follow: “(1) the immortal soul”; the eternal value of the ‘person’— (2) the solution, the judgment the evaluation in the ‘beyond’— (3) moral values as the supreme values, the ‘salvation of the soul’ as one’s cardinal interest— (4) ‘sin,’ ‘earthly,’ ‘flesh,’ ‘appetites’ stigmatized as ‘world’ ” 18 “A gay monster is worth more than a sentimental bore.” Cf. section 91 below. 21 “Sodass sie mitklingt”: Cf. Rilke’s famous “Liebes-Lied” (1907), reprinted with translation in Walter Kaufmann, *Twenty German Poets*; also, Thus Spoke Zarathustra IV (pity as Zarathustra’s great temptation), in *Portable Nietzsche*. 26 A method that strengthens. According to 1911, pp 498 f, this note is superscribed “A Preface” and has the appearance of a quick draft—and “a few paragraphs that did not fit well into the context had to be omitted” The original version of the second paragraph read: “Vice is whatever weakens—whatever exhausts” And the next paragraph: “Conversely, I call good whatever makes strong, whatever stores.” And the following passages were omitted by the original editor: “I have to teach first of all that crime, celibacy, and sickness are consequences of exhaustion. [Nietzsche himself, of course, was celibate and far from well.] “Plunging down—negating life—that, too, was supposed to be experienced as a kind of sunrise transfiguration, deification. “I want to make the concept of ‘progress’ more precise and am afraid that toward that end I have to fly in the face of modern

ideas (but I am comforted by the fact that they really have no faces but only masks). “Diseased limbs should be amputated: the first moral of society. “A correction of the instincts: their detachment from ignorance— “I despise those who demand of society that it ought to protect itself from those who would harm it. That is not enough by a long shot. Society is a body in which no member may be diseased without endangering the whole. A diseased member that corrupts [the reading of this word is not certain] has to be amputated: I shall name the amputable types of society.” II. HISTORY OF EUROPEAN NIHILISM 57 (1884) My friends, it was hard for us when we were young: we suffered youth itself like a serious sickness. That is due to the time into which we have been thrown—a time of extensive inner decay and disintegration, a time that with all its weaknesses, and even with its best strength, opposes the spirit of youth. Disintegration characterizes this time, and thus uncertainty: nothing stands firmly on its feet or on a hard faith in itself; one lives for tomorrow, as the day after tomorrow is dubious.³⁴ Everything on our way is slippery and dangerous, and the ice that still supports us has become thin: all of us feel the warm, uncanny breath of the thawing wind;³⁵ where we still walk, soon no one will be able to walk. 58 (1885-1888) If this is not an age of decay and declining vitality, it is at least one of headlong and arbitrary experimentation:—and it is probable that a superabundance of bungled experiments should create an overall impression as of decay—and perhaps even decay itself. 59 (1885-1886) Toward a History of the Modern Eclipse The state nomads (civil servants, etc.): without home. The decline of the family. The “good man” as a symptom of exhaustion. Justice as will to power (breeding). Lasciviousness and neurosis. Black music: whither refreshing music? The anarchist. Contempt for man, nausea. Deepest difference: whether hunger or overabundance becomes creative? The former generates the ideals of romanticism.³⁷ Nordic unnaturalness. The need for alcoholica: the “distress” of the workers. Philosophical nihilism. 60 (1885) The slow emergence and rise of the middle and lower classes (including the lower kind of spirit and body), of which one finds many preludes before the French Revolution—and it would have taken place without the Revolution, too—on the whole, then, the predominance of the herd over all shepherds and bellwethers—involves eclipse of the spirit (the fusion of a Stoic and a frivolous appearance of happiness, characteristic of noble cultures, decreases; one lets much suffering be seen and heard that one formerly bore and hid); moral hypocrisy (a way of wishing to distinguish oneself not by means of morality, but by means of the herd virtues: pity, consideration, moderation, which are not recognized and honored outside the herd ability); a really great amount of shared suffering (pity) and joy (the pleasure in large-scale associations found in all herd animals—“community spirit,” “Fatherland,” everything in which the individual does not count).

61 (Summer-Fall 1883)

Our time, with its aspiration to remedy and prevent accidental distresses and to wage preventive war against disagreeable possibilities, is a time of the poor. Our “rich”—are poorest of all. The true purpose of all riches is forgotten.

62 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Critique of modern man (his moralistic mendaciousness):³⁸ —the “good man” corrupted and seduced by bad institutions (tyrants and priests); —reason as authority; —history as overcoming of errors; —the future as progress; —the Christian state (“the Lord of hosts”); —the Christian sex impulse (or marriage); —the kingdom of “justice” (the cult of “humanity”); —“freedom.” The romantic pose of modern man: —the noble man (Byron, Victor Hugo, George Sand); —noble indignation; —consecration through passion (as true “nature”); —siding with the oppressed and underprivileged: motto of the historians and novelists; —the Stoics of duty; —selflessness as art and knowledge; —altruism as the most mendacious form of egoism (utilitarianism), most sentimental egoism. All this is eighteenth century. What, on the other hand, has not been inherited from it: insouciance, cheerfulness, elegance, brightness of the spirit. The tempo of the spirit has changed; the enjoyment of refinement and clarity of the spirit has given place to the enjoyment of color, harmony, mass, reality, etc. Sensualism in matters of the spirit. In short, it is the eighteenth century of Rousseau.

63 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

On the whole, a tremendous quantum of humaneness has been attained in present-day mankind. That this is not felt generally is itself a proof: we have become so sensitive concerning small states of distress that we unjustly ignore what has been attained. Here one must make allowance for the existence of much decadence, and seen with such eyes our world has to look wretched and miserable. But such eyes have at all times seen the same things: a certain overirritation even of the moral feelings; the quantum of embitterment and eclipse that pessimism carries into judgments: these two together account for the predominance of the opposite notion, that our morality is in a bad way. The fact of credit, of worldwide trade, of the means of transportation—here a tremendous mild trust in man finds expression.— Another contributing factor is the emancipation of science from moral and religious purposes: a very good sign that, however, is usually misunderstood. In my own way I attempt a justification of history.

64 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The second Buddhism. The nihilistic catastrophe that finishes Indian culture.— Early signs of it: The immense increase of pity. Spiritual weariness. The reduction of problems to questions of pleasure and displeasure. The war glory that provokes a counterstroke. Just as national demarcation provokes a countermovement, the most cordial “fraternity.” The impossibility for religion to go on working with dogmas and fables.

65 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

What is attacked deep down today is the instinct and the will of tradition: all institutions that owe their origins to this instinct violate the taste of the modern spirit.— At bottom, nothing is thought and done without the purpose of eradicating this sense for tradition. One considers tradition a fatality; one studies it, recognizes it (as “heredity”), but one does not want it. The tensing of a will over long temporal distances, the selection of the states and valuations that allow one to dispose of future centuries—precisely this is antimodern in the highest degree. Which goes to show that it is the disorganizing principles that give our age its character.

66 (Spring-Fall 1887)

“Be simple!”—for us complicated and elusive triers of the reins a demand that is a simple stupidity.— Be natural! But how if one happens to be “unnatural”? 67 (1884) The former means for obtaining homogeneous, enduring characters for long generations: unalienable landed property, honoring the old (origin of the belief in gods and heroes as ancestors). Now the breaking up of landed property belongs to the opposite tendency: newspapers (in place of daily prayers), railway, telegraph. Centralization of a tremendous number of different interests in a single soul, which for that reason must be very strong and protean.

68 (March-June 1888)

Why everything turns into histrionics.— Modern man lacks: the sure instinct (consequence of a long homogeneous form of activity of one kind of man); the inability to achieve anything perfect is merely a consequence of this: as an individual one can never make up for lost schooling. That which creates a morality, a code of laws: the profound instinct that only automatism makes possible perfection in life and creation. But now we have reached the opposite point; indeed, we wanted to reach it: the most extreme consciousness, man's ability to see through himself and history. With this we are practically as far as possible from perfection in being, doing, and willing: our desire, even our will for knowledge is a symptom of a tremendous decadence. We strive for the opposite of that which strong races, strong natures want—understanding is an ending.— That science is possible in this sense that is cultivated today is proof that all elementary instincts, life's instincts of self-defense and protection, no longer function. We no longer collect, we squander the capital of our ancestors, even in the way in which we seek knowledge.— 69 (1885-1886)39 Nihilistic Trait a. In the natural sciences ("meaninglessness"); causalism, mechanism. "Lawfulness" an entr'acte, a residue. b. Ditto in politics: one lacks the faith in one's right, innocence; mendaciousness rules and serving the moment. c. Ditto in economics: the abolition of slavery. The lack of a redeeming class, one that justifies—advent of anarchism. "Education"? d. Ditto in history: fatalism, Darwinism; the final attempts to read reason and divinity into it fail. Sentimentality in face of the past; one could not endure a biography!— (Here, too, phenomenism: character as a mask; there are no facts.) e. Ditto in art: romanticism and its counterstroke (aversion against romantic ideals and lies). The latter, moral as a sense of greater truthfulness, but pessimistic. Pure "artists" (indifferent toward content). (Father-confessor psychology and puritan psychology, two forms of psychological romanticism: but even its counterproposal, the attempt to adopt a purely artistic attitude toward man—even there the opposite valuation is not yet ventured!) 70 (1885-1886) Against the doctrine of the influence of the milieu and external causes: the force within is infinitely superior; much that looks like external influence is merely its adaptation from within. The very same milieus can be interpreted and exploited in opposite ways: there are no facts.— A genius is not explained in terms of such conditions of his origin.40

71 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

“Modernity” in the perspective of the metaphor of nourishment and digestion.—Sensibility immensely more irritable (—dressed up moralistically: the increase in pity—); the abundance of disparate impressions greater than ever: cosmopolitanism in foods, literatures, newspapers, forms, tastes, even landscapes. The tempo of this influx prestissimo; the impressions erase each other; one instinctively resists taking in anything, taking anything deeply, to “digest” anything; a weakening of the power to digest results from this. A kind of adaptation to this flood of impressions takes place: men unlearn spontaneous action, they merely react to stimuli from outside. They spend their strength partly in assimilating things, partly in defense, partly in opposition. Profound weakening of spontaneity: the historian, critic, analyst, the interpreter, the observer, the collector, the reader—all of them reactive talents—all science! Artificial change of one’s nature into a “mirror”; interested but, as it were, merely epidermically interested; a coolness on principle, a balance, a fixed low temperature closely underneath the thin surface on which warmth, movement, “tempest,” and the play of waves are encountered. Opposition of external mobility and a certain deep heaviness and weariness.

72 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Where does our modern world belong—to exhaustion or ascent?— Its manifoldness and unrest conditioned by the attainment of the highest level of consciousness.

73 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Overwork, curiosity and sympathy—our modern vices.

74 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Toward a characterization of “modernity.”— Overabundant development of intermediary forms; atrophy of types; traditions break off, schools; the overlordship of the instincts (prepared philosophically: the unconscious worth more) after the will power, the willing of end and means, has been weakened. 75 (1885) An able craftsman or scholar cuts a fine figure when he takes pride in his art and looks on life content and satisfied. But nothing looks more wretched than when a shoemaker or schoolmaster gives us to understand with a suffering mien that he was really born for something better. There is nothing better than what is good— and good is having some ability and using that to create, *Tüchtigkeit* or *virtù* in the Italian Renaissance sense. Today, in our time when the state has an absurdly fat stomach, there are in all fields and departments, in addition to the real workers, also “representatives”; e g, besides the scholars also scribblers, besides the suffering classes also garrulous, boastful ne’er-do-wells who “represent” this suffering, not to speak of the professional politicians who are well off while “representing” distress with powerful lungs before a parliament Our modern life is extremely expensive owing to the large number of intermediaries; in an ancient city, on the other hand, and, echoing that, also in many cities in Spain and Italy, one appeared oneself and would have given a hoot to such modern representatives and intermediaries—or a kick!

76 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The predominance of dealers and intermediaries in spiritual matters, too: the scribbler, the “representative,” the historian (who fuses past and present), the exotician and cosmopolitan, the intermediaries between science and philosophy, the semitheologians. 77 (1883-1888) Nothing to date has nauseated me more than the parasites of the spirit: in our unhealthy Europe one already finds them everywhere—and they have the best conscience in the world. Perhaps a little dim, a little air pessimiste, but in the main voracious, dirty, dirtying, creeping in, nestling, thievish, scurvy—and as innocent as all little sinners and microbes They live off the fact that other people have spirit and squander it: they know that it is of the very essence of the rich spirit to squander itself carelessly, without petty caution, from day to day.— For the spirit is a bad householder and pays no heed to how everybody lives and feeds on it. 78 (1885-1886) Histrionics The colorfulness of modern man and its charm. Essentially concealment and satiety. The scribbler. The politician (in “the nationalist swindle”). Histrionics in the arts: lack of probity in prior training and schooling (Fromentin),⁴¹ the romantics (lack of philosophy and science and superabundance of literature); the novelists (Walter Scott, but also the Nibelungen monsters along with the most nervous music); the lyric poets. Being “scientific.” Virtuosos (Jews). Popular ideals overcome, but not yet in the eyes of the people: the saint, the sage, the prophet.

79 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The modern spirit's lack of discipline, dressed up in all sorts of moral fashions.
— The showy words are: tolerance (for “the incapacity for Yes and No”); *la largeur de sympathie* (= one-third indifference, one-third curiosity, one-third pathological irritability); “objectivity” (lack of personality, lack of will, incapacity for “love”); “freedom” versus rules (romanticism); “truth” versus forgery and lies (naturalism); being “scientific” (the “document humain”: in other words, the novel of *colportage* and addition in place of composition); “passion” meaning disorder and immoderation; “depth” meaning confusion, the profuse chaos of symbols.

80 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Toward a critique of the big words — I am full of suspicion and malice against what they call “ideals”: this is my pessimism, to have recognized how the “higher feelings” are a source of misfortune and man’s loss of value. One is deceived every time one expects “progress” from an ideal; every time so far the victory of the ideal has meant a retrograde movement. Christianity, the revolution, the abolition of slavery, equal rights, philanthropy, love of peace, justice, truth: all these big words have value only in a fight, as flags: not as realities but as showy words for something quite different (indeed, opposite!).⁴³ 81 (1883-1888) One knows the kind of human being who has fallen in love with the motto, *tout comprendre c’est tout pardonner*.⁴⁴ It is the weak, it is above all the disappointed: if there is something to be forgiven in all, perhaps there is also something to be despised in all. It is the philosophy of disappointment that wraps itself so humanely in pity and looks sweet. These are romantics whose faith flew the coop: now they at least want to watch how everything passes and goes. They call it *l’art pour l’art*, “objectivity,” etc.

82 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Chief symptoms of pessimism: the dîners chez Magny;⁴⁵ Russian pessimism (Tolstoy, Dostoevsky); aesthetic pessimism, l'art pour l'art, "description" (romantic and antiromantic pessimism); epistemological pessimism (Schopenhauer, phenomenism); anarchistic pessimism; the "religion of pity," Buddhistic premovement; cultural pessimism (exoticism, cosmopolitanism); moralistic pessimism: I myself.

83 (Spring-Fall 1887)

“Without the Christian faith,” Pascal thought, “you, no less than nature and history, will become for yourselves un monstre et un chaos.” This prophecy we have fulfilled, after the feeble-optimistic eighteenth century had prettified and rationalized man. Schopenhauer and Pascal.— In an important sense, Schopenhauer is the first to take up again the movement of Pascal: un monstre et un chaos, consequently something to be negated.— History, nature, man himself. “Our inability to know the truth is the consequence of our corruption, our moral decay”; thus Pascal. And thus, at bottom, Schopenhauer. “The deeper the corruption of reason, the more necessary the doctrine of salvation”—or, in Schopenhauer’s terms, negation.

84 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Schopenhauer as throwback (state before the revolution): Pity, sensuality, art, weakness of the will, Catholicism of spiritual cravings—that is good eighteenth century *au fond*.⁴⁶ Schopenhauer's basic misunderstanding of the will (as if craving, instinct, drive were the essence of will) is typical: lowering the value of the will to the point of making a real mistake. Also hatred against willing; attempt to see something higher, indeed that which is higher and valuable, in willing no more, in "being a subject without aim and purpose" (in the "pure subject free of will"). Great symptom of the exhaustion or the weakness of the will: for the will is precisely that which treats cravings as their master and appoints to them their way and measure.⁴⁷

85 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The unworthy attempt has been made to see Wagner and Schopenhauer as types of mental illness: one would gain an incomparably more essential insight by making more precise scientifically the type of decadence both represent. 86 (1888) Your Henrik Ibsen has become very clear to me. For all his robust idealism and “will to truth” he did not dare to liberate himself from the illusionism of morality that speaks of “freedom” without wishing to admit to itself what freedom is: the second stage in the metamorphosis of the “will to power”—for those who lack freedom. On the first stage one demands justice from those who are in power. On the second, one speaks of “freedom”—that is, one wants to get away from those in power. On the third, one speaks of “equal rights”—that is, as long as one has not yet gained superiority one wants to prevent one’s competitors from growing in power.

87 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Decline of Protestantism: understood as a halfway house both theoretically and historically. Actual superiority of Catholicism; the feeling of Protestantism extinguished to such an extent that the strongest anti-Protestant movements are no longer experienced as such (for example, Wagner's Parsifal). All of the higher regions of the spirit in France are Catholic in their instincts; Bismarck realizes that Protestantism simply doesn't exist any more.

88 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Protestantism, that spiritually unclean and boring form of decadence in which Christianity has been able so far to preserve itself in the mediocre north: valuable for knowledge as something complex and a halfway house, in so far as it brought together in the same heads experiences of different orders and origins.

89 (March-June 1888)

How did the German spirit transform Christianity!— And to stick to Protestantism: how much beer there is in Protestant Christianity! Can one even imagine a spiritually staler, lazier, more comfortably relaxed form of the Christian faith than that of the average Protestant in Germany?⁴⁹ That's what I call a modest version of Christianity! A homoeopathy of Christianity is what I call it. One reminds me that today we also encounter an immodest Protestantism—that of the court chaplains and anti-Semitic speculators: but nobody has claimed yet that any “spirit” whatever “moved” on the faces of these waters.— That is merely a more indecent form of Christianity, by no means more sensible.

90 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Progress.— Let us not be deceived! Time marches forward; we'd like to believe that everything that is in it also marches forward—that the development is one that moves forward. The most level-headed are led astray by this illusion. But the nineteenth century does not represent progress over the sixteenth; and the German spirit of 1888 represents a regress from the German spirit of 1788. "Mankind" does not advance, it does not even exist. The overall aspect is that of a tremendous experimental laboratory in which a few successes are scored, scattered throughout all ages, while there are untold failures, and all order, logic, union, and obligingness are lacking. How can we fail to recognize that the ascent of Christianity is a movement of decadence?— That the German Reformation is a recrudescence of Christian barbarism?— That the Revolution destroyed the instinct for a grand organization of society? Man represents no progress over the animal: the civilized tenderfoot is an abortion compared to the Arab and Corsican; the Chinese is a more successful type, namely more durable, than the European. 91 (1885) On German Pessimism The eclipse, the pessimistic coloring, comes necessarily in the wake of the Enlightenment. Around 1770 the decline of cheerfulness began to be noticed; women, with that feminine instinct which always sides with virtue, supposed that immorality was the cause. Galiani hit the nail on the head: he cites Voltaire's verse: *Un monstre gai vaut mieux Qu'un sentimental ennuyeux*.⁵³ When I believe now that I am a few centuries ahead in Enlightenment not only of Voltaire but even of Galiani, who was far pro-founder—how far must I have got in the increase of darkness!⁵⁴ And this is really the case, and I bewared in time, with some sort of regret, of the German and Christian narrowness and inconsequence of pessimism à la Schopenhauer or, worse, Leopardi, and sought out the most quintessential forms (Asia).⁵⁵ But in order to endure this type of extreme pessimism (it can be perceived here and there in my *Birth of Tragedy*) and to live alone "without God and morality" I had to invent a counterpart for myself. Perhaps I know best why man alone laughs: he alone suffers so deeply that he had to invent laughter. The unhappiest and most melancholy animal is, as fitting, the most cheerful. 92 (1883-1888) Regarding German culture, I have always had the feeling of decline. This fact, that I first became acquainted with a type in decline, has often made me unfair to the whole phenomenon of European culture. The Germans always come after the others, much later: they are carrying something in the depths; e.g.,— Dependence on other countries; e.g., Kant—Rousseau, Sensualists, Hume, Swedenborg. Schopenhauer—Indians and romanticism, Voltaire. Wagner— French cult of the gruesome and of grand opera, Paris and the flight into primeval states (marriage with the sister). —The law of the latecomers (province

to Paris, Germany to France). Why the Germans of all people discovered the Greek spirit (the more one develops a drive, the more attractive does it become to plunge for once into its opposite). Music is swan song.⁵⁶

93 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Renaissance and Reformation.— What does the Renaissance prove? That the reign of the individual has to be brief. The squandering is too great; the very possibility of collecting and capitalizing is lacking; and exhaustion follows immediately. These are times when everything is spent, when the very strength is spent with which one collects, capitalizes, and piles riches upon riches.— Even the opponents of such movements are forced into an absurd waste of energy; they, too, soon become exhausted, spent, desolate. In the Reformation we possess a wild and vulgar counterpart to the Italian Renaissance, born of related impulses; only in the retarded north, which had remained coarse, they had to don a religious disguise; for there the concept of the higher life had not yet detached itself from that of the religious life. Through the Reformation, too, the individual sought freedom; “everybody his own priest” is also a mere formula of libertinage. In truth, one word was enough—“evangelical freedom”—and all instincts that had reason to remain hidden broke out like wild dogs, the most brutal requirements suddenly acquired the courage to face themselves, and everything seemed justified.— One was careful not to understand what liberty one had really meant at bottom; one shut one’s eyes before oneself.— But shutting one’s eyes and moistening one’s lips with enthusiastic orations did not prevent one’s hands from grasping whatever could be grabbed, and the belly became the god of the “free evangel,” and all the cravings of revenge and envy satisfied themselves with insatiable rage.— This took a while; then exhaustion set in, just as it had in the south of Europe—and here, too, a vulgar kind of exhaustion, a general ruere in servitium.⁵⁷— The indecent century of Germany arrived.— 94 (1884) Chivalry as the conquered position of power: its gradual breaking up (and in part transition into what is more spread out, bourgeois). In La Rochefoucauld we find a consciousness of the true motive springs of noblesse of the mind—and a view of these motive springs that is darkened by Christianity. The French Revolution as the continuation of Christianity. Rousseau is the seducer: he again unfetters woman who is henceforth represented in an ever more interesting manner—as suffering. Then the slaves and Mrs. Beecher-Stowe. Then the poor and the workers. Then the vice addicts and the sick—all this is moved into the foreground (even to develop sympathy for the genius one no longer knows any other way for the past five hundred years than to represent him as the bearer of great suffering!). Next come the curse on voluptuousness (Baudelaire and Schopenhauer); the most decided conviction that the lust to rule is the greatest vice;⁵⁸ the perfect certainty that morality and disinterestedness are identical concepts and that the “happiness of all” is a goal worth striving for (i.e., the kingdom of heaven of Christ). We are well along on the way: the kingdom of heaven of the poor in spirit has begun.— Intermediary stages: the bourgeois (a

parvenu on account of money) and the worker (on account of the machine).
Comparison of Greek culture and that of the French in the age of Louis XIV.
Decided faith in oneself. A leisure class whose members make things difficult for themselves and exercise much self-overcoming. The power of form, the will to give form to oneself. "Happiness" admitted as a goal. Much strength and energy behind the emphasis on forms. The delight in looking at a life that seems so easy.
— To the French, the Greeks looked like children.

95 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The Three Centuries Their different sensibilities are best expressed thus:

Aristocratism: Descartes, rule of reason, testimony of the sovereignty of the will;

Feminism: Rousseau, rule of feeling, testimony of the sovereignty of the senses,

mendacious; Animalism: Schopenhauer, rule of craving, testimony of the

sovereignty of animality, more honest but gloomy. The seventeenth century is

aristocratic, imposes order, looks down haughtily upon the animalic, is severe

against the heart, not cozy, without sentiment, “un-German,” averse to what is

burlesque and what is natural, inclined to generalizations and sovereign

confronted with the past—for it believes in itself. Much beast of prey au fond,

much ascetic habit to remain master. The century of strong will; also of strong

passion. The eighteenth century is dominated by woman, given to enthusiasm,

full of esprit, shallow, but with a spirit in the service of what is desirable, of the

heart, libertine in the enjoyment of what is most spiritual, and undermines all

authorities; intoxicated, cheerful, clear, humane, false before itself, much canaille

au fond, sociable.— The nineteenth century is more animalic and subterranean,

uglier, more realistic and vulgar, and precisely for that reason “better,” “more

honest,” more submissive before every kind of “reality,” truer; but weak in will,

but sad and full of dark cravings, but fatalistic. Not full of awe and reverence for

either “reason” or “heart”; deeply convinced of the rule of cravings

(Schopenhauer spoke of “will”; but nothing is more characteristic of his

philosophy than the absence of all genuine willing). Even morality reduced to

one instinct (“pity”). Auguste Comte is a continuation of the eighteenth century

(domination of *coeur* over *la tête*, sensualism in the theory of knowledge,

altruistic enthusiasm). That science has become sovereign to such a degree

proves how the nineteenth century has rid itself of the domination of ideals. A

certain frugality of desire makes possible our scientific curiosity and severity—

which is our kind of virtue.— Romanticism is an echo of the eighteenth century;

a kind of piled-high desire for its enthusiasm in the grand style (as a matter of

fact, a good deal of histrionics and self-deception: one wanted to represent strong

natures and grand passions). The nineteenth century looks instinctively for

theories that seem to justify its fatalistic submission to matters of fact. Already

Hegel’s success against “sentimentality” and romantic idealism was due to his

fatalistic way of thinking, to his faith in the greater reason on the side of the

victorious, to his justification of the actual “state” (in place of “mankind,” etc.).

— Schopenhauer: we are something stupid and, at best, even something that

cancels itself.⁵⁹ Success of determinism, of the genealogical derivation of

obligations that had formerly been considered absolute, the doctrine of milieu

and adaptation, the reduction of will to reflexes, the denial of the will as an

“efficient cause”; finally—a real rechristening: one sees so little will that the

word becomes free to designate something else. Further theories: the doctrine of objectivity—"will-less" contemplation—as the only road to truth; also to beauty (—also the faith in the "genius" to justify a right to submission); mechanism, the calculable rigidity of the mechanical process; the alleged "naturalism," elimination of the choosing, judging, interpreting subject as a principle— Kant, with his "practical reason" and his moral fanaticism is wholly eighteenth century; still entirely outside the historical movement; without any eye for the actuality of his time, e.g., Revolution; untouched by Greek philosophy; fanciful visionary of the concept of duty; sensualist with the backdrop of the pampering of dogmatism.— The movement back to Kant in our century is a movement back to the eighteenth century: one wants to regain a right to the old ideals and the old enthusiasm—for that reason an epistemology that "sets boundaries," which means that it permits one to posit as one may see fit a beyond of reason.— Hegel's way of thinking is not far different from Goethe's: one needs only to listen to Goethe about Spinoza. Will to deify the universe and life in order to find repose and happiness in contemplation and in getting to the bottom of things; Hegel seeks reason everywhere—before reason one may submit and acquiesce. In Goethe a kind of almost joyous and trusting fatalism that does not revolt, that does not flag, that seeks to form a totality out of himself, in the faith that only in the totality everything redeems itself and appears good and justified.⁶⁰

96 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Period of the Enlightenment—followed by the period of sentimentality. To what extent Schopenhauer belongs to “sentimentality” (Hegel to spirituality).⁶¹

97 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The seventeenth century suffers of man as of a sum of contradictions (“l’amas de contradictions” that we are); it seeks to discover, order, excavate man—while the eighteenth century seeks to forget what is known of man’s nature in order to assimilate him to its utopia. “Superficial, tender, humane”—enthusiastic about “man”—The seventeenth century seeks to erase the tracks of the individual to make the work look as similar to life as possible. The eighteenth uses the work in an attempt to arouse interest in the author. The seventeenth century seeks in art—art, a piece of culture; the eighteenth uses art to make propaganda for reforms of a social and political nature. “Utopia,” the “ideal man,” the deification of nature, the vanity of posing, the subordination to propaganda for social goals, charlatanism—these are our gifts from the eighteenth century. The style of the seventeenth century: propre, exact et libre. The strong individual, self-sufficient or zealously occupied before God—and this modern obtrusiveness of authors who all but leap out at you—these furnish some contrast. “To perform”—compare that with the scholars of Port-Royal. Alfieri had a sense for grand style. Hatred of the burlesque (undignified), lack of a sense for nature belong to the seventeenth century.

98 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Against Rousseau.— Unfortunately, man is no longer evil enough; Rousseau's opponents who say "man is a beast of prey" are unfortunately wrong. Not the corruption of man but the extent to which he has become tender and moralized is his curse.⁶³ Precisely in the sphere that Rousseau fought most violently one could find the relatively still strong and well-turned-out type of man (those in whom the grand affects were still unbroken: will to power, will to enjoyment, will and capacity to command). The man of the eighteenth century has to be compared with the man of the Renaissance (also with the man of the seventeenth century in France), so that one feels what is at stake: Rousseau is a symptom of self self-contempt and heated vanity—both signs that the domineering will is lacking: he moralizes and, as a man of rancor, seeks the cause of his wretchedness in the ruling classes.

99 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Against Rousseau.⁶⁴— The state of nature is terrible, man is a beast of prey; our civilization represents a tremendous triumph over this beast-of-prey nature: thus argued Voltaire. He felt the mitigation, the subtleties, the spiritual joys of the civilized state; he despised narrowmindedness, also in the form of virtue, and the lack of delicatessen, also among ascetics and monks. The moral reprehensibility of man seemed to preoccupy Rousseau; with the words “unjust” and “cruel” one can best stir up the instincts of the oppressed who otherwise smart under the ban of the vetitum and disfavor, so their conscience advises them against rebellious cravings. Such emancipators seek one thing above all: to give their party the grand accents and poses of the higher nature.

100 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Rousseau: the rule based on feeling; nature as the source of justice; man perfects himself to the extent to which he approaches nature (according to Voltaire, to the extent to which he moves away from nature). The very same epochs are for one ages of the progress of humanity; for the other, times when injustice and inequality grow worse. Voltaire still comprehended *umanità* in the Renaissance sense; also *virtù* (as “high culture”); he fights for the cause of the “*honnêtes gens*” and “*de la bonne compagnie*,”⁶⁵ the cause of taste, of science, of the arts, of progress itself and civilization. The fight began around 1760: the citizen of Geneva and *le seigneur de Ferney*.⁶⁶ Only from that moment on Voltaire becomes the man of his century, the philosopher, the representative of tolerance and unbelief (till then merely *un bel esprit*).⁶⁷ Envy and hatred of Rousseau’s success impelled him forward, “to the heights.” Pour “*la canaille*” un dieu remunerateur et vengeur—Voltaire. Critique of both points of view in regard to the value of civilization. The social invention is for Voltaire the most beautiful there is: there is no higher goal than to maintain and perfect it; precisely this is *honnêteté*,⁶⁹ to respect social conventions; virtue as obedience to certain necessary “prejudices” in favor of the preservation of “society.” Missionary of culture, aristocrat, representative of the victorious, ruling classes and their valuations. But Rousseau remained a plebeian, also as *homme de lettres*;⁷⁰ that was unheard of; his impudent contempt of all that was not he himself. What was sick in Rousseau was admired and imitated most. (Lord Byron related to him; also worked himself up into sublime poses and into vindictive rancor; sign of “meanness”; later attained balance through Venice and comprehended what produces more ease and well-being—*l’insouciance*.)⁷¹ Rousseau is proud in regard to what he is, in spite of his origins; but he is beside himself when one reminds him of it.—Rousseau, beyond a doubt, mentally disturbed; in Voltaire an uncommon health and light touch. The rancor of the sick; the periods of his insanity also those of his contempt of man and his mistrust. The defense of providence by Rousseau (against the pessimism of Voltaire): he needed God in order to be able to cast a curse upon society and civilization; everything had to be good in itself because God had created it; only man has corrupted men. The “good man” as the natural man was pure fantasy; but with the dogma of God’s authorship it seemed probable and well-founded. Romanticism à la Rousseau: passion (“the sovereign right of passion”); “naturalness”; the fascination of madness (folly included in greatness); the absurd vanity of the weak man; the rancor of the mob as judge (“for a hundred years now, a sick man has been accepted as a leader in politics”).⁷²

101 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Kant: makes the epistemological skepticism of the English possible for Germans: by enlisting for it the sympathy of the moral and religious needs of the Germans; just as the later philosophers of the Academy used skepticism for the same reason, as a preparation for Platonism (vide Augustin); and as Pascal used even moralistic skepticism in order to excite the need for faith (“to justify it”); by scholastically involuting and curlicueing it and thus making it acceptable for the German taste regarding scientific form (for Locke and Hume in themselves were too bright, too clear, i.e., judged according to German value instincts, “too superficial”—) Kant: inferior in his psychology and knowledge of human nature; way off when it comes to great historical values (French Revolution); a moral fanatic à la Rousseau; a subterranean Christianity in his values; a dogmatist through and through, but ponderously sick of this inclination, to such an extent that he wished to tyrannize it, but also weary right away of skepticism; not yet touched by the slightest breath of cosmopolitan taste and the beauty of antiquity—a delayer and mediator, nothing original (just as Leibniz mediated and built a bridge between mechanism and spiritualism, as Goethe did between the taste of the eighteenth century and that of the “historical sense” (which is essentially a sense for the exotic), as German music did between French and Italian music, as Charlemagne did between imperium Romanum and nationalism—delayers par excellence.)⁷³

102 (Spring-Fall 1887)

In how far the Christian centuries with their pessimism were stronger centuries than the eighteenth century—like the tragic era of the Greeks. The nineteenth century vis-à-vis the eighteenth century. In what respects heir—in what respects a regression (poorer in “spirit” and taste)—in what respects progress (darker,⁷⁴ more realistic, stronger). 103 (1883-1888)⁷⁵ What does it mean that we have such a feeling for the *campagna Romana*? And for high mountain ranges? What is the meaning of our nationalism?⁷⁶ Chateaubriand in 1803, in a letter to M. de Fontanes, gives the first impression of the *campagna Romana*. President de Brosses says of the *campagna Romana*. “il fallait que Romulus fût ivre, quand il songea à bâtir une ville dans un terrain aussi laid.”⁷⁷ Delacroix, too, did not like Rome, it frightened him. He was enthusiastic about Venice, like Shakespeare, like Byron, like George Sand. This aversion to Rome also in Theoph. Gautier—and in Rich. Wagner. Lamartine has found language for Sorrent and Posilipp. Victor Hugo was enthusiastic about Spain, “parce que aucune autre nation n’a moins emprunté à l’antiquité, parce qu’elle n’a subi aucune influence classique.”⁷⁸

104 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The two great tentative ones, made to overcome the eighteenth century: Napoleon, by awakening again the man, the soldier, and the great fight for power—conceiving Europe as a political unit; Goethe, by imagining a European culture that would harvest the full inheritance of attained humanity. German culture of this century arouses mistrust—in music this full, redeeming and binding element of Goethe is lacking—The Austrians have remained German only by virtue of their music.⁷⁹ 105 (1883-1888) The preponderance of music in the romantics of 1839 and 1840. Delacroix. Ingres, a passionate musician (cult of Gluck, Haydn, Beethoven, Mozart), said to his students in Rome, “si je pouvais vous rendre tous musiciens, vous y gagneriez comme peintres”;⁸⁰ also Horace Vernet, with a special passion for Don Giovanni (as Mendelssohn testifies, 1831); also Stendhal, who said of himself: Combien de lieues ne ferais-je pas à pied, et à combien de jours de prison ne me soumettrais-je pas pour entendre Don Juan ou le Matrimonio segreto et je ne sais pour quelle autre chose je ferais cet effort.⁸¹ At that time he was 56. Borrowed forms; e g, Brahms as typical “epigone”; Mendelssohn’s educated Protestantism, ditto (an earlier “soul” is recaptured poetically—) —moral and poetical substitutions in Wagner, one art as stopgap for deficiencies in the others —the “historical sense,” inspiration from poetry and ancient sagas —that typical transformation of which G. Flaubert offers the clearest example among the French and Richard Wagner among the Germans, in which the romantic faith in love and the future is transformed into the desire for the nothing, 1830 into 1850.

106 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Why does German music culminate in the period of German romanticism? Why is Goethe missing in German music? How much Schiller—more precisely, how much “Thekla”⁸²—there is in Beethoven! Schumann has in himself Eichendorff, Uhland, Heine, Hoffmann, Tieck. Richard Wagner has Freischütz,⁸³ Hoffmann, Grimm, the romantic saga, the mystical Catholicism of instinct, symbolism, the “libertinism of passion” (Rousseau’s intent). The Flying Dutchman tastes of France, where le ténébreux was the type of the seducer in 1830. Cult of music, of the revolutionary romanticism of form. Wagner sums up romanticism, German as well as French— 107 (1888) Estimated merely for his value for Germany and German culture, Richard Wagner remains a great question mark, perhaps a German misfortune, in any case a destiny: but what does it matter? Isn’t he very much more than merely a German event? It even seems to me that there is no place where he belongs less than Germany: nothing was prepared for him there; his whole type remains simply strange among Germans, odd, uncomprehended, incomprehensible. But one is careful not to admit this to oneself: for that one is too kindly, too square,⁸⁵ too German. “Credo quia absurdus est”:⁸⁶ that is what the German spirit wants and also wanted in this case—and so it believes for the present whatever Wagner wanted people to believe about him. The German spirit has at all times lacked subtlety and divination in psychologicis. Today, under the high pressure of fatherlandism and self-admiration, it is visibly thickening and becoming coarser: how should it be capable of coping with the problem of Wagner!— 108 (1885) So far, the Germans are nothing, but they will become something; thus they have no culture yet—thus they cannot have any culture yet. That is my proposition: let those who cannot help it take offense.— So far they are nothing: that means, they are all sorts of things. They will become something: that means, they will stop some day being all sorts of things. The latter is at bottom a mere wish, scarcely a hope; fortunately, a wish on which one can live, a matter of will, of work, of discipline, of breeding, as well as a matter of annoyance,⁸⁷ of desire, of missing something, of discomfort, even of embitterment—in brief, we Germans desire something from ourselves that has not yet been desired from us—we desire something more! That this “German as he is not yet” deserves something better than today’s German “Bildung”;⁸⁸ that all who are “in the process of becoming” must be furious when they perceive some satisfaction in this area, an impertinent “retiring on one’s laurels” or “self-congratulation”: that is my second proposition on which I also have not yet changed my mind. 109 (1885) Principle: There is an element of decay in everything that characterizes modern man: but close beside this sickness stand

signs of an untested force and powerfulness of the soul. The same reasons that produce the increasing smallness of man drive the stronger and rarer individuals up to greatness.⁸⁹

110 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Overall insight: the ambiguous character of our modern world—the very same symptoms could point to decline and to strength. And the signs of strength, of the attainment of majority, could be misconstrued as weakness on the basis of traditional (residual) negative emotional valuations. In brief, our feelings, as feelings about values, are not up to date. To generalize: feelings about values are always behind the times; they express conditions of preservation and growth that belong to times long gone by; they resist new conditions of existence with which they cannot cope and which they necessarily misunderstand: thus they inhibit and arouse suspicion against what is new.—

111 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The problem of the nineteenth century. Whether its strong and weak sides belong together? Whether it is all of one piece? Whether the diverseness of its ideals and their mutual inconsistency are due to a higher aim: as something higher?— For it could be the precondition of greatness to grow to such an extent in violent tension. Dissatisfaction, nihilism could be a good sign.

112 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Overall insight.—Actually, every major growth is accompanied by a tremendous crumbling and passing away: suffering, the symptoms of decline belong in the times of tremendous advances; every fruitful and powerful movement of humanity has also created at the same time a nihilistic movement. It could be the sign of a crucial and most essential growth, of the transition to new conditions of existence, that the most extreme form of pessimism, genuine nihilism, would come into the world. This I have comprehended. 113 (1883-1888) (A) To begin with a full and cordial tribute to contemporary humanity: not to be deceived by appearances—this type of humanity is less striking but gives far better warranties of duration; its tempo is slower, but the beat is much richer. Health is increasing, the actual conditions for a strong body get recognized and are slowly created, “asceticism” ironice.⁹⁰ One shrinks from extremes; a certain confidence in the “right road”;⁹¹ no enthusing; temporary acclimatization to narrower values (like “fatherland,” like “scholarship,” etc.). Still, this whole picture would remain ambiguous: it could be an ascending but also a descending movement of life. (B) Faith in “progress”—in the lower spheres of intelligence it appears as ascending life; but this is self-deception; in the higher spheres of intelligence as descending life. Description of the symptoms. Unity of point of view: uncertainty about standards of value. Fear of a general “in vain.” Nihilism. 114 (June 10, 1887)⁹² Actually, we have no longer such need of an antidote to the first nihilism: life in our Europe is no longer that uncertain, capricious, absurd. Such a tremendous increase in the value of man, the value of trouble, etc., is not so needful now; we can take a significant decrease of this value, we may concede much absurdity and caprice: the power man has attained now permits a demotion of the means of breeding of which the moral interpretation was the strongest. “God” ’ is far too extreme a hypothesis.

115 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

If anything signifies our humanization—a genuine and actual progress—it is the fact that we no longer require excessive oppositions, indeed no opposites at all—we may love the senses, we have spiritualized and made them artistic in every degree; we have a right to all those things which were most maligned until now.

93

116 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The inversion of the order of rank.— The pious counterfeiters, the priests, among us become chandalas—they replace the charlatans, quacks, counterfeiters, and wizards; we consider them corrupters of the will, great slanderers of life on which they wish to revenge themselves, rebels among the underprivileged. We have turned the caste of servants, the Sudras, into our middle class, our “Volk” [“people”], those who make political decisions.⁹⁴ On the other hand, the chandala of former times is at the top: foremost, those who blaspheme God, the immoralists, the nomads of every type, the artists, Jews, musicians—at bottom, all disreputable classes of men— We have raised ourselves to the level of honorable thoughts; even more, we determine honor on earth, “nobility”— All of us are today advocates of life.— We immoralists are today the strongest power: the other great powers need us—we construe the world in our image— We have transferred the concept of the “chandala” to the priests, teachers of a beyond, and the Christian society that is grown together with them, as well as all who are of the same origin, the pessimists, nihilists, romantics of pity, criminals, vice addicts— the whole sphere in which the concept of “God” is imagined as a savior— We are proud of no longer having to be liars, slanderers, men who cast suspicion on life—⁹⁵ 117 (Spring-Fall 1887)⁹⁶ Progress of the nineteenth century against the eighteenth (—at bottom we good Europeans wage a war against the eighteenth century—): “Return to nature” understood more and more decisively in the opposite sense from Rousseau’s. Away from idyl and opera! more and more decisively anti-idealistic, more concrete, more fearless, industrious, moderate, suspicious against sudden changes, antirevolutionary; more and more decisively the question concerning the health of the body is put ahead of that of “the soul”: the latter being understood as a state consequent upon the former, and the former at the very least as a precondition of the health of the soul. 118 (1883-1888) If anything at all has been achieved, it is a more innocuous relation to the senses, a more joyous, benevolent, Goethean attitude toward sensuality; also a prouder feeling regarding the search for knowledge, so that the “pure fool”⁹⁷ is not given much credit.

119 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. 1888)

We who are “objective.”— It is not “pity” that opens the gates to the most distant and strange types of being and culture to us, but rather our accessibility and lack of partiality that does not empathize with or share suffering but on the contrary takes delight in a hundred things that formerly led people to suffer (feel outraged or deeply moved, or prompted hostile and cold looks—). Suffering in all its nuances has become interesting for us: in this respect we are certainly not fuller of pity, even when we are shaken by the sight of suffering and moved to tears: we do not by any means for that reason feel like helping. In this voluntary desire to contemplate all sorts of distress and transgressions we have become stronger and more vigorous than the eighteenth century was; it is a proof of our increase in vigor (we have come closer to the seventeenth and sixteenth centuries—). But it is a profound misunderstanding to construe our “romanticism” as a proof that our “souls” have become “more beautiful”— We desire strong sensations as all coarser ages and social strata do.— This should be distinguished from the needs of those with weak nerves and the decadents: they have a need for pepper, even for cruelty— All of us seek states in which bourgeois morality no longer has any say, and priestly morality even less (—every book to which some of the air of pastors and theologians still clings gives us the impression of a pitiable niaiserie and poverty.— “Good society” consists of those whom at bottom nothing interests except what is forbidden in bourgeois society and gives a bad reputation: the same applies to books, music, politics, and the estimation of woman.

120 (Spring-Fall 1887)

How man has become more natural in the nineteenth century (the eighteenth century is that of elegance, refinement, and sentiments *généreux*).— Not “return to nature”—for there has never yet been a natural humanity. The scholasticism of un- and antinatural values is the rule, is the beginning; man reaches nature only after a long struggle—he never “returns”— Nature: i.e., daring to be immoral like nature. We are coarser, more direct, full of irony against generous feelings even when we succumb to them. More natural is our first society, that of the rich, the leisure class: they hunt each other, love between the sexes is a kind of sport in which marriage furnishes an obstacle and a provocation; they amuse themselves and live for pleasure; they esteem physical advantages above all, are curious and bold. More natural is our attitude to the search for knowledge: we possess libertinage of the spirit in all innocence, we hate pompous and hieratical manners, we delight in what is most forbidden, we should hardly know any longer of any interest of knowledge if the way to it were paved with boredom. More natural is our attitude toward morality. Principles have become ridiculous; nobody permits himself any longer to speak without irony of his “duty.” But a helpful, benevolent disposition is esteemed (morality is found in an instinct, and the rest is spurned.¹⁰¹ In addition a few concepts of points of honor—). More natural is our position in politics: we see problems of power, of one quantum of power against another. We do not believe in any right that is not supported by the power of enforcement: we feel all rights to be conquests. More natural is our estimation of great human beings and great things: we consider passion a privilege, we consider nothing great unless it includes a great crime; we conceive all being-great as a placing-oneself-outside as far as morality is concerned. More natural is our attitude toward nature: we no longer love it on account of its “innocence,” “reason,” or “beauty”; we have made it nicely “devilish” and “dumb.” But instead of despising it on that account, we have felt more closely related to it ever since, more at home in it. It does not aspire to virtue, and for that we respect nature. More natural is our attitude toward art: we do not demand beautiful illusory lies from it, etc.; brutal positivism reigns, recognizing facts without becoming excited. In summa: there are signs that the European of the nineteenth century is less ashamed of his instincts; he has taken a goodly step toward admitting to himself his unconditional naturalness, i.e., his immorality, without becoming embittered—on the contrary, strong enough to endure only this sight. This sounds to some ears as if corruption had progressed— and it is certain that man has not come close to that “nature” of which Rousseau speaks but has progressed another step in civilization, which Rousseau abhorred. We have become stronger: we have again come closer to the seventeenth century, especially to the taste of its end (Dancourt, Lesage, Regnard).¹⁰² 121 (1888)

Culture contra civilization.¹⁰³— The high points of culture and civilization do not coincide: one should not be deceived about the abysmal antagonism of culture and civilization. The great moments of culture were always, morally speaking, times of corruption; and conversely, the periods when the taming of the human animal (“civilization”) was desired and enforced were times of intolerance against the boldest and most spiritual natures. Civilization has aims different from those of culture—perhaps they are even opposite—

122 (January-Fall 1888)

What I warn against: the instincts of decadence should not be confused with humaneness;¹⁰⁴ the means of civilization, which lead to disintegration and necessarily to decadence, should not be confused with culture; the libertinage, the principle of “laissez aller,” should not be confused with the will to power (— which is the counterprinciple).

123 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The unfinished problems I pose anew: the problem of civilization, the fight between Rousseau and Voltaire around 1760. Man becomes more profound, mistrustful, “immoral,” stronger, more confident of himself—and to this extent “more natural”: this is “progress.”— At the same time, in accordance with a kind of division of labor, the strata that have become more evil are separated from those that have become milder and tamer—so that the overall fact is not noticed immediately.— It is characteristic of strength, of the self-control and fascination of strength, that these stronger strata possess the art of making others experience their progress in evil as something higher. It is characteristic of every “progress” that the strengthened elements are reinterpreted as “good.”

124 (Spring-Fall 1887)

To give men back the courage to their natural drives— To check their self-underestimation (not that of man as an individual but that of man as nature—)— To remove antitheses from things after comprehending that we have projected them there— To remove the idiosyncrasies of society from existence (guilt, punishment, justice, honesty, freedom, love, etc.)— Progress toward “naturalness”: in all political questions, also in the relations of parties, even of commercial, workers’, and employers’ parties, questions of power are at stake —“what one can do,” and only after that what one ought to do.¹⁰⁵ 125 (1885)¹⁰⁶ Socialism—as the logical conclusion of the tyranny of the least and the dumbest, i.e., those who are superficial, envious, and three-quarters actors—is indeed entailed by “modern ideas” and their latent anarchism; but in the tepid air of democratic well-being the capacity to reach conclusions, or to finish, weakens. One follows—but one no longer sees what follows. Therefore socialism is on the whole a hopeless and sour affair; and nothing offers a more amusing spectacle than the contrast between the poisonous and desperate faces cut by today’s socialists—and to what wretched and pinched feelings their style bears witness!—and the harmless lambs’ happiness of their hopes and desiderata. Nevertheless, in many places in Europe they may yet bring off occasional coups and attacks: there will be deep “rumblings” in the stomach of the next century, and the Paris commune, which has its apologists and advocates in Germany, too, was perhaps no more than a minor indigestion compared to what is coming. But there will always be too many who have possessions for socialism to signify more than an attack of sickness—and those who have possessions are of one mind on one article of faith: “one must possess something in order to be something.” But this is the oldest and healthiest of all instincts: I should add, “one must want to have more than one has in order to become more.” For this is the doctrine preached by life itself to all that has life: the morality of development. To have and to want to have more—growth, in one word—that is life itself. In the doctrine of socialism there is hidden, rather badly, a “will to negate life”; the human beings or races that think up such a doctrine must be bungled. Indeed, I should wish that a few great experiments might prove that in a socialist society life negates itself, cuts off its own roots. The earth is large enough and man still sufficiently unexhausted; hence such a practical instruction and demonstratio ad absurdum would not strike me as undesirable, even if it were gained and paid for with a tremendous expenditure of human lives. In any case, even as a restless mole under the soil of a society that wallows in stupidity, socialism will be able to be something useful and therapeutic: it delays “peace on earth” and the total mollification of the democratic herd animal; it forces the Europeans to retain spirit, namely cunning and cautious care, not to abjure manly

and warlike virtues altogether, and to retain some remnant of spirit, of clarity, sobriety, and coldness of the spirit— it protects Europe for the time being from the *marasmus femininus* that threatens it.

126 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The most favorable inhibitions and remedies of modernity: 1. universal military service with real wars in which the time for joking is past; 2. national bigotry (simplifies, concentrates); 3. improved nutrition (meat); 4. increasing cleanliness and healthfulness of domiciles; 5. hegemony of physiology over theology, moralism, economics, and politics; 6. military severity in the demand for and handling of one's "obligations" (one does not praise any more—). 127 (1884) I am glad about the military development of Europe; also of the internal states of anarchy: the time of repose and Chinese ossification, which Galiani predicted for this century, is over. Personal manly virtù,¹⁰⁸ virtù of the body,¹⁰⁹ is regaining value, estimation becomes more physical, nutrition meatier. Beautiful men are again becoming possible. Pallid hypocrisy (with mandarins at the top, as Comte dreamed) is over. The barbarian in each of us is affirmed; also the wild beast. Precisely for that reason philosophers have a future.— Kant is a scarecrow, some day!¹¹⁰ 128 (1884) I have as yet found no reason for discouragement. Whoever has preserved, and bred in himself, a strong will, together with an ample spirit, has more favorable opportunities than ever. For the trainability of men has become very great in this democratic Europe; men who learn easily and adapt themselves easily are the rule: the herd animal, even highly intelligent, has been prepared. Whoever can command finds those who must obey: I am thinking, e.g., of Napoleon and Bismarck. The rivalry with strong and unintelligent wills, which is the greatest obstacle, is small. Who doesn't topple these "objective" gentlemen with weak wills, like Ranke or Renan! 129 (1885) Spiritual enlightenment is an infallible means for making men unsure, weaker in will, so they are more in need of company and support—in short, for developing the herd animal in man. Therefore all great artists of government so far (Confucius in China, the imperium Romanum, Napoleon, the papacy at the time when it took an interest in power and not merely in the world), in the places where the dominant instincts have culminated so far, also employed spiritual enlightenment—at least let it have its way (like the popes of the Renaissance). The self-deception of the mass concerning this point, e.g., in every democracy, is extremely valuable: making men smaller and more governable is desired as "progress"! 130 (1883-1888) The highest equity and mildness as a state of weakening (the New Testament and the original Christian community—apparent as complete *bêtise* in the Englishmen, Darwin and Wallace). Your equity, you higher natures, impels you toward suffrage universel, etc.; your "humanity," toward mildness confronted with crime and stupidity. In the long run you thus make stupidity and the unscrupulous victorious: comfort and stupidity—the mean. Externally: age of tremendous wars, upheavals, explosions. Internally: ever greater weakness of man, events as excitants. The Parisian as the European extreme. Consequences: (1) barbarians

(at first, of course, below the form of culture so far [e.g., Dühring]); (2) sovereign individuals (where masses of barbarian force are crossed with a lack of all restraint regarding whatever has been). Age of the greatest stupidity, brutality, and the masses, and of the highest individuals. 131 (1884) Innumerable individuals of a higher type now perish: but whoever gets away is strong as the devil. Similar to the situation at the time of the Renaissance. 132 (1885) Good Europeans that we are—what distinguishes us above the men of fatherlands?—First, we are atheists and immoralists, but for the present we support the religions and moralities of the herd instinct: for these prepare a type of man that must one day fall into our hands, that must desire our hands. Beyond good and evil—but we demand that herd morality should be held sacred unconditionally. We hold in reserve many types of philosophy which need to be taught: possibly, the pessimistic type, as a hammer; a European Buddhism might perhaps be indispensable. We probably support the development and maturing of democratic institutions: they enhance weakness of the will: in socialism we see a thorn that protects against comfortableness. Position toward peoples. Our preferences; we pay attention to the results of interbreeding. Apart, wealthy, strong: irony at the expense of the “press” and its culture. Worry lest scholars become journalistic. We feel contemptuous of every kind of culture that is compatible with reading, not to speak of writing for, newspapers. We take our accidental positions (like Goethe, Stendhal), our experiences, as foreground and stress them to deceive about our depths. We ourselves are waiting and beware of staking our hearts on them. They serve us as hostels for a night, which a wanderer needs and accepts—we beware of settling down. We are ahead of our fellow men in possessing a *disciplina voluntatis*. All strength applied to development of strength of the will, an art that permits us to wear masks, an art of understanding beyond the affects (also to think in a “supra-European” way, at times). Preparation for becoming the legislators of the future, the masters of the earth, at least our children. Basic concern with marriages. 133 (1885) The twentieth century.—Abbé Galiani once said: *La prévoyance est la cause des guerres actuelles de l’Europe. Si Von voulait se donner la peine de ne rien prévoir, tout le monde serait tranquille, et je ne crois pas qu’on serait plus malheureux parce qu’on ne ferait pas la guerre.* 114 Since I do not by any means share the unwarlike views of my friend Galiani, I am not afraid of predicting a few things and thus, possibly, of conjuring up the cause of wars. A tremendous stock-taking after the most terrible earthquake: with new questions. 134 (1885-1886) This is the time of the great noon, of the most terrible clearing up: my type of pessimism—great point of departure. I. Basic contradiction in civilization and the enhancement of man. II. Moral valuations as a history of lies and the art of slander in the service of a will to power (the herd will that rebels against the human beings who are stronger). III. The conditions of every enhancement of culture (making possible a selection at the expense of a

mass) are the conditions of all growth. IV. The multiple ambiguity of the world as a question of strength that sees all things in the perspective of its growth. Moral-Christian value judgments as slaves' rebellion and slaves' mendaciousness (against the aristocratic values of the ancient world). How far does art reach down into the essence of strength?¹¹⁸ *The Will to Power Attempt at a Revaluation of all Values.* (In four books) **FIRST BOOK:** The danger of dangers (presentation of nihilism as the necessary consequence of our valuations so far). Tremendous forces have been unleashed; but they conflict with each other; they annihilate each other. In a democratic commonwealth, where everybody is a specialist, the what-for? and for-whom? are lacking. The class [Stand] in which the thousandfold atrophy of all individuals (into mere functions) acquires meaning. **SECOND BOOK:** Critique of values (logic, etc). Everywhere the disharmony between the ideal and its individual conditions (e.g., honesty among Christians who are continually forced to lie). **THIRD BOOK:** The problem of the legislator (including the history of solitude) The forces that have been unleashed must be harnessed again lest they annihilate each other; eyes have to be opened for the actual increase of strength. **FOURTH BOOK:** The hammer. What would men have to be like whose valuations are the opposite? Men who have all the traits of the modern soul but are strong enough to transform them into so much health—their means for their task. *SILS MARIA.* Summer 1886. Plan of the first book What is dawning is the opposition of the world we revere and the world we live and are. So we can abolish either our reverence or ourselves. The latter constitutes nihilism. The advent of nihilism, theoretical and practical Its faulty derivation (pessimism, its kinds: preludes of nihilism, although not necessary). Christianity perishing of its morality. "God is truth"; "God is love"; "the just God."—The greatest event—"God is dead"—perceived dimly. Morality, now without any sanction, no longer knows how to maintain itself. Eventually one drops the moral interpretation (echoes of the Christian value judgments still fill men's feelings). But it was upon moral judgments that value was based so far; above all, the value of philosophy ("of the will to truth"). (The popular ideals—"the sage," "the prophet," "the saint"—have collapsed.) Nihilistic trait in the natural sciences.... [(5) through (9) appear above as (a) through (e).] For the second book Origin and critique of moral valuations These two things don't coincide, as is often supposed (this belief itself is the result of a moral judgment to the effect that "something that has come to be in such and such a way is worth little because its origin is immoral") Standard for determining the value of moral valuations: critique of the words, "Improvement, perfecting, enhancement" The basic fact that has been overlooked: the contradiction between "becoming more moral" and the enhancement and strengthening of the type of man. *Homo natura.* The "will to power" For the third book The will to power. How those men would have to be constituted who would accomplish this revaluation in themselves. The

order of rank as an order of power: war and danger as presuppositions that a rank maintains its conditions The grandiose model: man in nature—the weakest, cleverest being making itself master and subjugating the more stupid elements For the fourth book The greatest struggle: for that a new weapon is needed. The hammer: to conjure up a terrible decision, to confront Europe with the final choice whether its will “wills” its own destruction [Untergang]. Prevention of the decline into mediocrity [Vermittelmässigung]. Rather even destruction [Lieber noch Untergang]! In the preface to *Twilight of the Idols*, written in 1888 and published in January 1889, the image of the hammer is sublimated: “For once to pose questions here with a hammer, and, perhaps, to hear as a reply that famous hollow sound which speaks of bloated entrails—what a delight for one who has ears even behind his ears, for me, an old psychologist ...” For the dictum, “God is dead,” see *The Gay Science*, section 125 (Portable Nietzsche, pp. 95 f) and *Zarathustra*, Prologue (ibid, p. 124); also Kaufmann’s *Nietzsche*, Chapter 3. Of the men enumerated in the parenthesis, all but the last three are mentioned in *The Will to Power* (see the Index), and of these all but Gautier are also mentioned in the books Nietzsche himself published In *Twilight*, “Skirmishes,” whole sections are devoted to Renan (#2) and Sainte Beuve (#3), the brothers Goncourt are characterized in sections 1 and 7; and Flaubert is mentioned often, also in Nietzsche’s other books Practically all of these references are hostile. (For Renan see also my note on *Genealogy III*, section 26.) Hippolyte Taine, on the other hand, is mentioned favorably in *Beyond Good and Evil* and in the *Genealogy*, and Nietzsche corresponded with him. Edmond Henri Adolphe Schérer (1815-89), ordained and appointed to a professorship in the *Ecole Evangélique* at Geneva in 1843, resigned six years later and gradually abandoned Protestant doctrine. He became a Hegelian, settled in Paris, and made his reputation as a literary critic. Gavarni was the pen name of Sulpice Guillaume Chevalier (1801-66), an outstanding Parisian caricaturist He is said to have initiated the *dîners chez Magny*, mentioned in the text Ivan Sergeyevich Turgenev (1818-83), the great Russian novelist, is never mentioned in Nietzsche’s books. On January 11, 1888, Brandes had written Nietzsche that he was sending him the proofs of a collection of his essays: “... The essay on Ibsen is relatively the best.... There is a Nordic writer whose works would interest you. Søren Kierkegaard; he lived 1813-1855 and is in my view one of the most profound psychologists of all time....” Nietzsche replied February 19: “... I have decided that during my next trip to Germany I want to study the psychological problem of Kierkegaard . .” Ibsen he did not mention—and he never got around to reading Kierkegaard. On March 7, Brandes wrote Nietzsche: “Ibsen must interest you as a personality Unfortunately he does not have the same stature as a human being that he has as a poet As a mind he has been very dependent on Kierkegaard and is still rather full of theology Bjornson actually became a common lay preacher during his last

phase....” And November 23, 1888, Brandes wrote Nietzsche: “Believe me, I make propaganda for you wherever I can. Only last week I seriously urged Henrik Ibsen to study your works There is a way in which you are related to him, too, although very distantly. This oddball is great and strong and unfriendly but nevertheless deserving of love Strindberg will be pleased that you esteem him ...” Nietzsche refers to Ibsen in two other places: in section 747 in *The Will to Power* and in *Ecce Homo*, Chapter III, section 5, where he says: “A whole species of malignant ‘idealism’—which, incidentally, is encountered among men, too; for example in Henrik Ibsen, this typical old maid—has the aim of poisoning the good conscience, that which is natural in sexual love.” What Nietzsche had actually read of Ibsen’s works is uncertain His friend Franz Overbeck wrote him on October 14, 1888: “In Munich I have also had a few strange impressions in the theater, and have scarcely ever seen a more skillful German play than *The Pillars of Society* by Ibsen, by whom I had not known anything before this....” Michael Meyer, the Ibsen scholar and translator, informs me that the only record he has found of any comment on Nietzsche by Ibsen is in an interview printed in the newspaper *Ørebladet*, November 26, 1900, when Ibsen was 72: “A great thinker has died since we last spoke, Herr Ibsen—Nietzsche. ‘Yes. I wasn’t well acquainted with his work It wasn’t until a few years ago that he really became well known. He had a remarkable talent, but his philosophy prevented him from becoming popular in our democratic age’ Some say that Nietzsche was a spirit who emerged from the dark—a Satan— ‘Satan—no No, Nietzsche wasn’t that’ ” Which isn’t much And according to Meyer, Ibsen often said he had “read little of Kierkegaard and understood less” Nevertheless it is widely taken for granted—and perhaps rightly—that Ibsen’s *Brand* was profoundly influenced by Kierkegaard and Ibsen’s *An Enemy of the People* brings to mind Kierkegaard’s paean on “That Individual,” with its refrain “The crowd is untruth” (found, e g, in my *Existentialism from Dostoevsky to Sartre*, 1956, pp 92-99) And *Beyond Good and Evil* (1886) contains some very striking parallels to *An Enemy of the People* (written in 1882), which evidently are not due to any influence of the play on Nietzsche’s book: see my note on section 213 of *Beyond Good and Evil*, as well as section 4 of my “Translator’s Preface” 49 “Ist eine geistig verdumpftere, faulere, gliederstreckendere Form des Christen-Glaubens noch denkbar, als die eines deutschen Durchschnitts-Protestanten?” Faul can mean “rotten” as well as “lazy”; gliederstreckend means literally “limb-stretching” 53 A gay monster is worth more Than a sentimental bore. Nietzsche omitted the text of this verse, which was inserted in the book by Peter Gast; cf section 35 above. 56 “Musik ist Ausklingen.” 57 “Plunging into servitude.” 67 A wit. 74 Düstere. Above, Verdüsterung has been rendered sometimes as “eclipse.” 86 “I believe because he is absurd” Variation of the famous, “I believe because it is absurd,” usually ascribed to Tertullian. The early editors’ intent in placing this note of 1885 after

the preceding note of 1888, by way of concluding a subsection (the subheads have been dropped above), is palpable: one did not wish to conclude with a sharp criticism of Germany and dredged up an older note in which Nietzsche had identified himself with the Germans, at least to some extent. The published statements of his last year speak for themselves: see *The Case of Wagner* and the chapter on the Germans (p. 505 in *Portable Nietzsche*) in *Twilight of the Idols*; also the chapter on *The Case of Wagner* in *Ecce Homo*. 98 “Nicht das ‘Mitleid’ ” and “welche gerade nicht ‘mitleidet’”: the German word for pity (*Mitleid*) means literally “suffering with”—like “compassion” and “sympathy” 101 “*Dédaignirt.*” I. In the one-volume edition of *The Will to Power* [1901], the aphorism to which Nietzsche assigned number 80 in W. II 1, 47/48 [the reference is to pp. 47/48 of one of his notebooks], was reproduced as aphorism 36. Weiss [in the two-volume edition of 1911, which—except for the important editorial apparatus at the end of the second volume—is merely a reprint of the second edition of 1906] made two [aphorisms] out of it (117 and 124), although Nietzsche had also listed this aphorism in W II 4 as ‘80: Progress of the growing naturalness of the nineteenth century.’ A juxtaposition of the two versions shows that in 124 in Weiss’s version the paragraph is missing that in the one-volume edition concludes the aphorism: ‘that meanwhile, in the midst of the mechanics of grand politics, the Christian trumpet is still sounded (for example, in bulletins about victories or in the Kaiser’s addresses to the nation), belongs more and more with the things that are becoming impossible; for it offends good taste.’ “*Schlechta* knows nothing of this, although it would have been useful to him in his reprint. It is equally unknown to him that the editors of *The Will to Power* of 1901 recorded in their notes (p. 131 [actually, 531]): ‘A short sentence has been omitted here’ Otto Weiss did not mention this. “The unpublished sentence reads: The throat of the crown prince is not one of God’s affairs’ ” This is scarcely an earth-shaking revelation. Indeed, it is of interest mainly as negative evidence: this is offered as one of the two “most important points”—*Wichtigstes* might also be rendered as “most significant”—that have eluded Podach’s predecessors down to *Schlechta*. Podach’s second example has already been considered in the footnote to section 2. (See also my article, cited at the end of that note) The “unpublished sentence” was evidently written in 1887, when the crown prince of Germany was suffering from a throat ailment that killed him a hundred days after he succeeded to the imperial throne in 1888. In his correspondence Nietzsche then expressed his respect for him and his disappointment—Friedrich III was a more likable emperor than his son and successor, Wilhelm II. The “unpublished sentence” clearly was not closely related to the contents of either section 117 or section 124 but merely a note Nietzsche had jotted down for himself, and posterity was not cheated by its suppression. It was evidently no more than a reaction to someone who had dragged in God in a way that had irritated Nietzsche. For facsimiles and

further discussion see front of book and Appendix. 108 Tüchtigkeit. 113 “E g.,
Dühring” is found only in 1911, p. 500. 114 “Foresight is the cause of Europe’s
present wars. If one would take pains to foresee nothing, the whole world would
be tranquil, and I do not believe that one would be worse off for not waging
war.” The quotation was inserted by Peter Gast. I. CRITIQUE OF RELIGION
All the beauty and sublimity we have bestowed upon real and imaginary things I
will reclaim as the property and product of man: as his fairest apology. Man as
poet, as thinker, as God, as love, as power: with what regal liberality he has
lavished gifts upon things so as to impoverish himself and make himself feel
wretched! His most unselfish act hitherto has been to admire and worship and to
know how to conceal from himself that it was he who created what he admired.

—2

135 (March-June 1888)

On the origin of religion.— In the same way as today the uneducated man believes that anger is the cause of his being angry, spirit the cause of his thinking, soul the cause of his feeling—in short, just as there is still thoughtlessly posited a mass of psychological entities that are supposed to be causes—so, at a yet more naive stage, man explained precisely the same phenomena with the aid of psychological personal entities. Those conditions that seemed to him strange, thrilling, overwhelming, he interpreted as obsession and enchantment by the power of a person. (Thus the Christian, the most naive and backward species of man today, traces hope, repose, the feeling of “redemption,” back to psychological inspiration by God: to him, as an essentially suffering and disturbed type, the feeling of happiness, resignation and repose naturally seems strange and in need of explanation.) Among intelligent, strong, and vigorous races it is mainly the epileptic who inspires the conviction that a strange power is here at work; but every related condition of subjection, e.g., that of the inspired man, of the poet, of the great criminal, of passions such as love and revenge, also leads to the invention of extrahuman powers. A condition is made concrete in a person, and when it overtakes us is thought to be effected by that person. In other words: In the psychological concept of God, a condition, in order to appear as effect, is personified as cause. The psychological logic is this: When a man is suddenly and overwhelmingly suffused with the feeling of power—and this is what happens with all great affects—it raises in him a doubt about his own person: he does not dare to think himself the cause of this astonishing feeling—and so he posits a stronger person, a divinity, to account for it. In summa: the origin of religion lies in extreme feelings of power which, because they are strange, take men by surprise: and like a sick man who, feeling one of his limbs uncommonly heavy, comes to the conclusion another man is lying on top of him, the naive homo religiosus divides himself into several persons. Religion is a case of “*altération de la personnalité*.” A sort of feeling of fear and terror at oneself— But also a feeling of extraordinary happiness and exaltation— Among the sick the feeling of health is sufficient to inspire belief in God, in the nearness of God.

136 (March-June 1888)

Rudimentary psychology of the religious man:— All changes are effects; all effects are effects of will (—the concept “nature,” “law of nature” is lacking); all effects suppose an agent. Rudimentary psychology: one is a cause oneself only when one knows that one has performed an act of will. Result: when man experiences the conditions of power, the imputation is that he is not their cause, that he is not responsible for them they come without being willed, consequently we are not their author: the will that is not free (i.e., the consciousness that we have been changed without having willed it) needs an external will.

Consequence: man has not dared to credit himself with all his strong and surprising impulses—he has conceived them as “passive,” as “suffered,” as things imposed upon him: religion is the product of a doubt concerning the unity of the person, an *altération* of the personality: in so far as everything great and strong in man has been conceived as superhuman and external, man has belittled himself—he has separated the two sides of himself, one very paltry and weak, one very strong and astonishing, into two spheres, and called the former “man,” the latter “God.” He has continued to think in this way; in the period of the moral idiosyncrasy he did not interpret his exalted and sublime moral states as “willed,” as “work” of the person. The Christian too divides his person into a mean and weak fiction which he calls man, and another which he calls God (redeemer, savior)— Religion has debased the concept “man”; its ultimate consequence is that everything good, great, true is superhuman and bestowed only through an act of grace—

137 (March-June 1888)

One way of raising man from the abasement produced by the subtraction of exalted and strong states as foreign conditions was the family theory. These exalted and strong states could at least be interpreted as the influence of our ancestors; we belonged together, in solidarity; we grow greater in our own eyes when we act according to a norm known to us. Attempt by noble families to square religion with the feeling of their own worth. Poets and seers do the same: they feel proud, honored, and chosen for such an association—they attach great importance to not being considered at all as individuals, but merely as mouthpieces (Homer). Step by step man takes possession of his exalted and proud states, he takes possession of his acts and works. Formerly one believed one was doing oneself an honor by denying responsibility for one's highest acts and attributing them to—God. Absence of free will counted as that which imparted a higher value to an action: a god was conceived as its author.⁴ 138 (1883-1888) Priests are the actors of something superhuman which they have to make easily perceptible, whether it be in the nature of ideals, gods, or saviors: in this they find their calling, for this their instincts serve them; to make everything as believable as possible they have to go as far as possible in posturing and posing; the shrewdness of their actor's art must above all aim at giving them a good conscience, by means of which alone is it possible to carry true conviction.

139 (March-June 1888)

The priest wants to have it understood that he counts as the highest type of man, that he rules—even over those who wield power—that he is indispensable, unassailable—that he is the strongest power in the community, absolutely not to be replaced or undervalued. Means he alone possesses knowledge; he alone possesses virtue; he alone has sovereign lordship over himself; he alone is in a certain sense God and goes back to the divinity; he alone is the intermediary between God and other people; the divinity punishes every opposition to, every thought directed against a priest. Means: truth exists. There is only one way of attaining it: to become a priest. Everything good in society, in nature, in tradition, is to be traced back to the wisdom of the priests. The holy book is their work. The whole of nature is only a fulfillment of the dogmas contained in it. There is no other source of the good than the priests. Every other kind of excellence is of a different order from that of the priest; e.g., that of the warrior. Consequence: if the priest is to be the highest type, then the degrees which lead to his virtues must constitute the degrees of value among men. Study, emancipation from the senses, the non-active, the impassible, absence of affects, the solemn; antithesis: the lowest order of man. The priest has taught one kind of morality: in order that he shall be considered the highest type of man. He conceives an antithetical type: the chandala. To make these contemptible by every means provides a foil to the order of castes.— The priest's extreme fear of sensuality is also conditioned by the insight that this is the most serious threat to the order of castes (that is, to order in general)— Every “more liberal tendency” in puncto puncti throws the marriage laws overboard—

140 (March-June 1888)

The philosopher as a further development of the priestly type:—has the heritage of the priest in his blood; is compelled, even as rival, to struggle for the same ends with the same means as the priest of his time; he aspires to supreme authority. What gives authority when one does not have physical power in one's hands (no army, no weapons of any kind—)? How, in fact, does one gain authority over those who possess physical strength and authority? (They compete with the awe inspired by princes, by the victorious conqueror, by the wise statesman). Only by arousing the belief that they have in their hands a higher, mightier strength—God. Nothing is sufficiently strong: the mediation and service of the priests is needed. They establish themselves as indispensable intermediaries: they need as conditions of their existence: (1) belief in the absolute superiority of their God, belief in their God; (2) that there is no other, no direct access to God. The second demand alone creates the concept “heterodoxy,” the first the concept “unbeliever” (i.e., one who believes in another God—).

1416 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Critique of the holy lie.— That the lie is permitted as a means to pious ends is part of the theory of every priesthood—to what extent it is part of their practice is the object of this inquiry. But philosophers too, as soon as, with priestly ulterior motives, they form the intention of taking in hand the direction of mankind, at once also arrogate to themselves the right to tell lies: Plato before all. The most imposing is the twofold lie developed by the typically Aryan philosophers of the Vedanta: two systems contradictory in all their main features but for educational reasons alternating, supplementary and complementary. The lie of the one is intended to create a condition in which alone the truth of the other can become audible— How far does the pious lie of priests and philosophers go?— One must ask what presuppositions they require for the purpose of education, what dogmas they have to invent to satisfy these presuppositions. First: they must have power, authority, unconditional credibility on their side. Secondly: they must have the whole course of nature in their hands, so that everything that affects the individual seems to be conditioned by their laws. Thirdly: they must also possess a more extensive domain of power whose control eludes the eyes of its subjects: power of punishment in the beyond, in the “after death”—and of course the means of discovering the way to bliss. —They have to set aside the concept of a natural course of events: but since they are clever and thoughtful people they are able to promise a host of effects, conditioned, of course, by prayers or the strict observance of their laws.— They can, moreover, prescribe a host of things that are absolutely reasonable—provided only that they do not point to experience or empiricism as the source of this wisdom, but to revelation or the consequence of “the sternest penances.” The holy lie therefore applies principally: to the purpose of an action (—natural purpose, reason are made to vanish: a moral purpose, the fulfillment of a law, a service to God appears as purpose—): to the consequence of an action (—natural consequence is interpreted as supernatural and, to produce a surer effect, the prospect of other, uncontrollable consequences is held out). In this way a concept of good and evil is created that seems to be altogether divorced from the natural concept “useful,” “harmful,” “life-promoting,” “life-retarding”—in so far as another life is imagined, it can even be directly inimical to the natural concept of good and evil. In this way the famous “conscience” is at last created: an inner voice which does not measure the value of every action with regard to its consequences, but with regard to its intention and the degree to which this intention conforms with the “laws.” The holy lie therefore invented (1) a God who punishes and rewards, who strictly observes the law-book of the priests and is strict about sending them into the world as his mouthpieces and plenipotentiaries; (2) an afterlife in which the great punishment machine is first thought to become effective—to this end the immortality of the soul; (3)

conscience in man as the consciousness that good and evil are permanent—that God himself speaks through it when it advises conformity with priestly precepts; (4) morality as denial of all natural processes, as reduction of all events to a morally conditioned event, moral effects (i.e., the idea of punishment and reward) as effects permeating all things, as the sole power, as the creator of all transformation; (5) truth as given, as revealed, as identical with the teaching of the priests: as the condition for all salvation and happiness in this life and the next. In summa: what is the price of moral improvement?— Unhinging of reason, reduction of all motives to fear and hope (punishment and reward); dependence upon a priestly guardianship, upon pedantic formalities which claim to express a divine will; the implanting of a “conscience” which sets a false knowing in place of testing and experiment: as if what should be done and what left undone had already been determined—a kind of castration of the seeking and forward-striving spirit; in summa: the worst mutilation of man that can be imagined presented as the “good man.” In practice, all the reason, the whole heritage of prudence, subtlety, caution which is the presupposition of the priestly canon, is afterwards arbitrarily reduced to a mere mechanism: conformity with the law itself counts as an end, as the highest end, life no longer has any problems; the whole conception of the world is polluted by the idea of punishment; with the object of representing the priestly life as the non plus ultra of perfection, life itself is transformed into a defamation and pollution of life; the concept “God” represents a turning away from life, a critique of life, even a contempt for it; truth is transformed into the priestly lie, the striving for truth into study of the scriptures, into a means of becoming a theologian—

142 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Toward a critique of the law-book of Manu.— The whole book is founded on the holy lie. Was the well-being of mankind the inspiration of this system? Was this species of man, who believes in the interestedness of every action, interested or not in imposing this system? To improve mankind—how is this intention inspired? Where is the concept of improvement derived from? We find a species of man, the priestly, which feels itself to be the norm, the high point and the supreme expression of the type man: this species derives the concept “improvement” from itself. It believes in its own superiority, it wills itself to be superior in fact: the origin of the holy lie is the will to power— Establishment of rule: to this end, the rule of those concepts that place a non plus ultra of power with the priesthood. Power through the lie—in the knowledge that one does not possess it physically, militarily—the lie as a supplement to power, a new concept of “truth.” It is a mistake to suppose an unconscious and naive development here, a kind of self-deception— Fanatics do not invent such carefully thought-out systems of oppression— The most cold-blooded reflection was at work here; the same kind of reflection as a Plato applied when he imagined his “Republic.” “He who wills the end must will the means”—all lawgivers have been clear in their minds regarding this politician’s insight. We possess the classic model in specifically Aryan forms: we may therefore hold the best-endowed and most reflective species of man responsible for the most fundamental lie that has ever been told— That lie has been copied almost everywhere: Aryan influence has corrupted all the world—8

143 (March-June 1888)

A lot is said today about the Semitic spirit of the New Testament: but what is called Semitic is merely priestly—and in the racially purest Aryan law-book, in Manu, this kind of “Semitism,” i.e., the spirit of the priest, is worse than anywhere else. The development of the Jewish priestly state is not original: they learned the pattern in Babylon: the pattern is Aryan. When, later on, the same thing became dominant in a Europe with a preponderance of Germanic blood, this was in accordance with the spirit of the ruling race: a great atavism. The Germanic Middle Ages aimed at a revival of the Aryan order of castes. Mohammedanism in turn learned from Christianity: the employment of the “beyond” as an instrument of punishment. The pattern of an unchanging community with priests at its head—this oldest of the great cultural products of Asia in the realm of organization—was bound to invite reflection and imitation in every respect. Again Plato: but above all the Egyptians. 144 (1885) Moralities and religions are the principal means by which one can make whatever one wishes out of man, provided one possesses a superfluity of creative forces and can assert one’s will over long periods of time—in the form of legislation, religions, and customs.⁹ 145 (1884-1888) What an affirmative Aryan religion, the product of the ruling class, looks like: the law-book of Manu. (The deification of the feeling of power in Brahma: interesting that it arose among the warrior caste and was only transferred to the priests.) What an affirmative Semitic religion, the product of a ruling class, looks like: the law-book of Mohammed, the older parts of the Old Testament. (Mohammedanism, as a religion for men, is deeply contemptuous of the sentimentality and mendaciousness of Christianity—which it feels to be a woman’s religion.) What a negative Semitic religion, the product of an oppressed class, looks like: the New Testament (—in Indian-Aryan terms: a chandala religion). What a negative Aryan religion looks like, grown up among the ruling orders: Buddhism. It is quite in order that we possess no religion of oppressed Aryan races, for that is a contradiction: a master race is either on top or it is destroyed.¹⁰ 146 (1885-1886) In itself, religion has nothing to do with morality: but both descendants of the Jewish religion are essentially moralistic religion —such as offer precepts about how one ought to live, and create a hearing for their demands by rewards and punishments.

147 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Pagan-Christian. The affirmation of the natural, the sense of innocence in the natural, “naturalness,” is pagan. The denial of the natural, the sense of degradation in the natural, unnaturalness, is Christian. Petronius, e.g., was “innocent”: compared with this happy man, a Christian is absolutely without innocence. But since ultimately the Christian status must be merely a natural condition—which, however, dares not conceive itself to be such—“Christian” signifies raising to a principle the counterfeiting of psychological interpretations — 148 (1883-1886) The Christian priest is from the first a mortal enemy of sensuality: no greather antithesis can be imagined than the innocently awed and solemn attitude adopted by, e.g., the most honorable women’s cults of Athens in the presence of the symbols of sex. The act of procreation is the mystery as such in all nonascetic religions: a sort of symbol of perfection and of the mysterious design of the future: rebirth, immortality. 149 (1880-1881) Belief in ourselves is the strongest fetter and the supreme whipping-on—and the strongest wing. Christianity should have made the innocence of man an article of faith—men would have become gods: belief was still possible in those days.¹¹

150 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The great lie in history: as if it was the corruption of paganism which opened the road to Christianity! It was, on the contrary, the weakening and moralization of the man of antiquity! Natural drives had already been reinterpreted as vices!¹²
151 (1885-1886) Religions are destroyed by belief in morality. The Christian moral God is not tenable: hence “atheism”—as if there could be no other kinds of god. Similarly, culture is destroyed by belief in morality. For when one discovers the necessary conditions out of which alone it can grow, one no longer wants it (Buddhism).

152 (March-June 1888)

Physiology of the nihilistic religions. Each and every nihilistic religion: a systematized case history of sickness employing religious-moralistic nomenclature. With pagan cults, it is around the interpretations of the great annual cycles that the cult revolves. With the Christian cult, it is around a cycle of paralytic phenomena that the cult revolves—

153 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

This nihilistic religion gathers together those decadence elements and the like that it finds in antiquity; namely: a. the party of the weak and ill-constituted (the refuse of the antique world: that which it thrust out most forcefully); b. the party of the morally-obsessed and antipagan; c. the party of the politically weary and the indifferent (blasé Romans), those without a country for whom life was emptiness; d. the party of those who were tired of themselves—who were glad to participate in a subterranean conspiracy—

154 (March-June 1888)

Buddha against the “Crucified.” Among the nihilistic religions, one may always clearly distinguish the Christian from the Buddhist. The Buddhist religion is the expression of a fine evening, a perfect sweetness and mildness—it is gratitude toward all that lies behind, and also for what is lacking: bitterness, disillusionment, rancor; finally, a lofty spiritual love; the subtleties of philosophical contradiction are behind it, even from these it is resting: but from these it still derives its spiritual glory and sunset glow. (—Origin in the highest castes—) The Christian movement is a degeneracy movement composed of reject and refuse elements of every kind: it is not the expression of the decline of a race, it is from the first an agglomeration of forms of morbidity crowding together and seeking one another out— It is therefore not national, not racially conditioned; it appeals to the disinherited everywhere; it is founded on a rancor against everything well-constituted and dominant: it needs a symbol that represents a curse on the well-constituted and dominant— It also stands in opposition to every spiritual movement, to all philosophy: it takes the side of idiots and utters a curse on the spirit. Rancor against the gifted, learned, spiritually independent: it detects in them the well-constituted, the masterful.

155 (Spring-Fall 1887)

In Buddhism this thought predominates: “All desires, all that produces affects and blood, draw one toward actions”—only to this extent is one warned against evil. For action—has no meaning, action binds one to existence: but all existence has no meaning. They see in evil a drive toward something illogical: to the affirmation of means to an end one denies. They seek a way of nonexistence and therefore they regard with horror all affective drives. E g., take no revenge! be no one’s enemy!— The hedonism of the weary is here the supreme measure of value. Nothing is further from Buddhism than the Jewish fanaticism of a Paul: nothing would be more repellent to its instincts than this tension, fire, unrest of the religious man, above all that form of sensuality that Christianity has sanctified with the name “love.” Moreover, it is the cultured and even the overspirited orders that find satisfaction in Buddhism: a race satiated and wearied by centuries of philosophical contentions, not, however, beneath all culture, like the classes from which Christianity arose— Emancipation even from good and evil appears to be of the essence of the Buddhist ideal: a refined state beyond morality is conceived that is identical with the state of perfection, in the presupposition that one needs to perform even good actions only for the time being, merely as a means—namely, as a means to emancipation from all actions.

156 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

A nihilistic religion [like Christianity],¹⁴ sprung from and appropriate to a people grown old and tame, having outlived all strong instincts—transferred step by step to another milieu, at length entering into youthful peoples which have not yet lived at all—very curious! The bliss of the close, the fold, the evening preached to barbarians and Germans! How thoroughly all that I first had to be barbarized, Germanized! To those who had dreamed a Valhalla: who found happiness only in war!—A supranational religion preached in a chaos where no nations even existed yet—

157 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The only way to refute priests and religions is this: to show that their errors have ceased to be beneficial—that they rather do harm; in short, that their own “proof of power” no longer holds good— 158 (1888) One should not confuse Christianity as a historical reality with that one root that its name calls to mind: the other roots from which it has grown up have been far more powerful. It is an unexampled misuse of words when such manifestations of decay and abortions as “Christian church,” “Christian faith” and “Christian life” label themselves with that holy name. What did Christ deny? Everything that is today called Christian.

159 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The entire Christian teaching as to what shall be believed, the entire Christian “truth,” is idle falsehood and deception: and precisely the opposite of what inspired the Christian movement in the beginning. Precisely that which is Christian in the ecclesiastical sense is anti-Christian in essence: things and people instead of symbols; history instead of eternal facts; forms, rites, dogmas instead of a way of life. Utter indifference to dogmas, cults, priests, church, theology is Christian. The Christian way of life is no more a fantasy than the Buddhist way of life: it is a means to being happy.

160 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Jesus starts directly with the condition the “Kingdom of Heaven” in the heart, and he does not find the means to it in the observances of the Jewish church; the reality of Judaism itself (its need to preserve itself) he regards as nothing; he is purely inward.— He likewise ignores the entire system of crude formalities governing intercourse with God: he opposes the whole teaching of repentance and atonement; he demonstrates how one must live in order to feel “deified”—and how one will not achieve it through repentance and contrition for one’s sins: “Sin is of no account” is his central judgment. Sin, repentance, forgiveness—none of this belongs here—it is acquired from Judaism, or it is pagan. 161 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)¹⁶ The Kingdom of Heaven is a condition of the heart (—it is said of children “for theirs is the Kingdom of Heaven”): Not something “above the earth.” The Kingdom of God does not “come” chronologically-historically, on a certain day in the calendar, something that might be here one day but not the day before: it is an “inward change in the individual,” something that comes at every moment and at every moment has not yet arrived—

162 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The thief on the Cross:— When even the criminal undergoing a painful death declares: “the way this Jesus suffers and dies, without rebelling, without enmity, graciously, resignedly, is the only right way,” he has affirmed the gospel: and with that he is in Paradise—

163 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Neither by deeds nor in your heart should you resist him who harms you. You should admit of no ground for divorcing your wife. You should make no distinction between strangers and neighbors, foreigners and fellow countrymen. You should be angry with no one, you should show contempt to no one. Give alms in secret. You should not want to become rich. You should not swear. You should not judge. You should be reconciled with foes; you should forgive. Do not pray publicly. “Bliss” is not something promised: it is there if you live and act in such and such a way.¹⁷

164 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The entire prophet and miracle-worker attitude, the anger, the calling down of judgment is a dreadful corruption (e.g., Mark 6, 11. And whosoever shall not receive you ... verily I say unto you, it shall be more tolerable for Sodom and Gomorrha, etc.). The "fig tree" (Matt. 21, 18): Now in the morning as he returned into the city, he hungered. And when he saw a fig tree in the way, he came to it, and found nothing thereon, but leaves only, and said unto it, "Let no fruit grow on thee henceforward forever." And presently the fig tree withered away.¹⁸

165 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

In a quite absurd way, the doctrine of reward and punishment has been crowded in: everything has thereby been ruined. In the same way, the practice of the first ecclesia militans,¹⁹ of the apostle [Paul]²⁰ and his attitude, has been represented in a quite falsifying way as commanded, as predetermined——. The subsequent glorification of the actual life and teaching of the first Christians: as if it had all been prescribed and the prescription merely followed— And as for the fulfillment of prophecies: what a mass of falsification and forgery!

166 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Jesus opposed the commonplace life with a real life, a life in truth: nothing was further from him than the stupid nonsense of an “eternalized Peter,” an eternal personal survival. What he fights against is this exaggerated inflation of the “person”: how can he desire to eternize precisely that? In the same way he fights against hierarchy within the community: he does not promise that reward shall be proportionate to performance: how can he have meant punishment and reward in the beyond!

167 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Christianity: a naive beginning to a Buddhist peace movement in the very seat of resentment—but reversed by Paul into a pagan mystery doctrine, which finally learns to treat with the entire state organization—and wages war, condemns, tortures, swears, hates. Paul starts from the need for a mystery felt by the broad, religiously excited masses: he seeks a sacrifice, a bloody phantasmagoria which will stand up in competition with the images of the mystery cults: God on the cross, blood-drinking, the unio mystica with the “sacrifice.” He seeks to bring the afterlife (the blissful, atoned afterlife of the individual soul) as resurrection into a causal relationship with that sacrifice (after the type of Dionysus, Mithras, Osiris). He needs to bring the concept guilt and atonement into the foreground, not a new way of life (as Jesus himself had demonstrated and lived) but a new cult, a new faith, a faith in a miraculous transformation (“redemption” through faith). He understood what the pagan world had the greatest need of, and from the facts of Christ’s life and death made a quite arbitrary selection, giving everything a new accentuation, shifting the emphasis everywhere—he annulled primitive Christianity as a matter or principle — The attempt to destroy priests and theologians culminated, thanks to Paul, in a new priesthood and theology—in a new ruling order and a church. The attempt to destroy the exaggerated inflation of the “person” culminated in faith in the “eternal person” (in concern for “eternal salvation”—), in the most paradoxical excess of personal egoism. This is the humor of the situation, a tragic humor: Paul re-erected on a grand scale precisely that which Christ had annulled through his way of living. At last, when the church was complete, it sanctioned even the existence of the state.

168 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

—The church is precisely that against which Jesus preached— and against which he taught his disciples to fight—

169 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

A god who died for our sins: redemption through faith; resurrection after death—all these are counterfeits of true Christianity for which that disastrous wrong-headed fellow [Paul]²¹ must be held responsible. The exemplary life consists of love and humility; in a fullness of heart that does not exclude even the lowliest; in a formal repudiation of maintaining one's rights, of self-defense, of victory in the sense of personal triumph; in faith in blessedness here on earth, in spite of distress, opposition and death; in reconciliation; in the absence of anger; not wanting to be rewarded; not being obliged to anyone; the completest spiritual-intellectual independence; a very proud life beneath the will to a life of poverty and service. After the church had let itself be deprived of the entire Christian way of life and had quite specifically sanctioned life under the state, that form of life that Jesus had combatted and condemned, it had to find the meaning of Christianity in something else: in faith in unbelievable things, in the ceremonial of prayers, worship, feasts, etc. The concept "sin," "forgiveness," "reward"—all quite unimportant and virtually excluded from primitive Christianity—now comes into the foreground. An appalling mishmash of Greek philosophy and Judaism; asceticism; continual judging and condemning; order of rank, etc.

170 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Christianity has from the outset transformed the symbolic into crudities: the antithesis “real life” and “false” life: misunderstood as “this life” and “the life to come”; the concept “eternal life,” the antithesis to transient personal life, as “personal immortality”; brotherhood on the basis of sharing food and drink together after the Hebrew-Arabic custom, as “the miracle of transubstantiation”; “resurrection—” understood as entry into “real life,” as a state of “rebirth”; this is made into an historical eventuality which takes place some time or other after death; the teaching that the son of man is the “Son of God,” the living relationship between God and man; this is made into the “second person of the divinity”—the filial relationship to God of every man, even the lowliest, is abolished; salvation through faith (namely, that there is no means of becoming a son of God except by following the way of life taught by Christ) reversed into the faith that one is to believe in some sort of miraculous subtraction of sins, accomplished not through man but through Christ’s deed: With that, “Christ on the cross” had to be interpreted anew. This death in itself was not at all the main thing—it had been only one more sign of how one ought to behave in relation to the authorities and laws of this world: not to defend oneself— That had been the lesson.

171 (March-June 1888)

Toward a psychology of Paul.— The given fact is the death of Jesus. This has to be explained— That an explanation may be true or false has never entered the minds of such people as these: one day a sublime possibility comes into their heads: “this death could mean such and such”—and at once it does mean such and such! A hypothesis is proved true by the sublime impetus it imparts to its originator— “The proof of power”: i.e., an idea is proved true by its effect—(“by their fruits” as the Bible naively says); what inspires must be true—that for which one sheds one’s blood must be true— Here, the sudden feeling of power that an idea arouses in its originator is everywhere accounted proof of its value: —and since one knows no way of honoring an idea other than by calling it true, the first predicate with which it is honored is the predicate “true”— How otherwise could it be so effective? It was imagined by some power: if that power were not real, it could not be effective— The idea is understood to have been inspired: the effect that it exercises possesses something of the violence of a demonic influence— An idea that such a decadent is unable to resist, to which he completely succumbs, is thus “proved” true! ! ! None of these holy epileptics and seers of visions possessed a thousandth part of that integrity in self-criticism with which a philologist today reads a text or proves the truth of an historical event— Compared with us, they are moral cretins—22

172 (Spring-Fall 1887)

That it does not matter whether a thing is true, but only what effect it produces—absolute lack of intellectual integrity. Everything is justified, lies, slander, the most shameless forgery, if it serves to raise the temperature—until one “believes”—A systematic school of the means to seduction to a faith: contempt, on principle, for the spheres from which contradiction might come (—the spheres of reason, philosophy and wisdom, mistrust, caution); a shameless praising and glorification of the doctrine, with constant reference to the fact that it was God who gave it—that the apostle signifies nothing—that nothing here is to be criticized, but only believed, accepted; that it is the most extraordinary grace and favor to receive such a doctrine of redemption; that the deepest gratitude and humility is the condition in which to receive it—The resentment which these lowly-placed persons feel toward everything held in honor is constantly gambled upon: that one represents this doctrine as a counterdoctrine in opposition to the wisdom of the world, to the power of the world, seduces them to it. It convinces the outcast and underprivileged of all kinds; it promises blessedness, advantage, privilege to the most insignificant and humble; it fills poor little foolish heads with an insane conceit, as if they were the meaning and the salt of the earth—All this, I repeat, one cannot sufficiently despise. We shall spare ourselves a critique of the doctrine; it suffices to observe the means it uses to know what it is one is dealing with. It identified with virtue, it shamelessly claimed for itself alone the whole fascinating force of virtue—it identified with the power of paradox and with the need felt by old civilizations for spice and absurdity; it amazed, it enraged, it provoked persecution and mistreatment—It is precisely the same well-pondered baseness with which the Jewish priesthood established its power and the Jewish church was created—One should distinguish: (1) that warmth of the passion “love” (resting on the subterranean basis of a heated sensuality); (2) the absolute ignobility of Christianity: —the continual exaggeration, the verbosity; —the lack of cool spirituality and irony; —the unmilitary nature of all its instincts; —the priestly prejudice against manly pride, against sensuality, the sciences, the arts.²³

173 (Summer-Fall 1888)

Paul: he seeks power in opposition to ruling Judaism—his movement is too weak — Revaluation of the concept “Jew”: the “race” is set aside—: but that means negating what is fundamental. The “martyr,” the “fanatic,” the value of all strong faith— Christianity is the decadent form of the old world sunk into deepest impotence, so that the sickest and unhealthiest elements and desires come to the top. Consequently, in order to create a unity, a resisting power, other instincts had to step into the foreground—in short, a kind of calamity was needed such as that from which the Jews had acquired their instinct for self-preservation— In this regard, the persecutions of the Christians were invaluable—a sense of community in danger, mass-conversion as the only means of putting an end to individual persecution (—consequently he takes as lightly as possible the concept “conversion”—).

174 (Spring-Fall 1887, rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

The Christian-Jewish life: here resentment did not predominate. Only the great persecutions could have developed this passion to this extent—the ardor of love as well as that of hatred. When one sees one's dearest sacrificed for one's faith, one becomes aggressive; we owe the triumph of Christianity to its persecutors. The asceticism in Christianity is not specifically Christian: this is what Schopenhauer misunderstood: it only makes inroads into Christianity wherever asceticism also exists apart from Christianity. Hypochondriac Christianity, the torturing and vivisection of the conscience, is in the same way only characteristic of a certain soil in which Christian values have taken root: it is not Christianity itself. Christianity has absorbed diseases of all kinds from morbid soil: one can only reproach it for its inability to guard against any infection. But that precisely is its essence: Christianity is a type of decadence.

175 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

The reality upon which Christianity could be raised was the little Jewish family of the Diaspora, with its warmth and affection, with its readiness to help and sustain one another—unheard-of and perhaps not understood in the whole Roman Empire—with its concealed pride of the “chosen” disguised as humility, with its innermost denial, untouched by envy, of all that is on top and possesses power and splendor. To have recognized in this a form of power, to have recognized that this blissful condition was communicable, seductive, infectious to pagans also—that was Paul’s genius: to employ this store of latent energy, of prudent happiness for a “Jewish church of freer confession”—the entire Jewish experience and mastery of communal self-preservation under foreign rule, also Jewish propaganda—he divined that as his task. What he lit upon was just this absolutely unpolitical and withdrawn species of little people: their art of asserting themselves and prevailing, cultivated through a number of virtues which constituted virtue in its entirety (“means by which a particular species of man preserves and enhances himself”). The principle of love derives from the little Jewish communities: it is a soul of the more passionate kind that glows here under the ashes of humility and wretchedness: this was neither Greek, nor Indian, nor Germanic. The song in praise of love that Paul composed is nothing Christian, but a Jewish outburst of the eternal flame that is Semitic. If Christianity has done anything essential psychologically, it is that it raised the temperature of the soul among those cooler and nobler races that were then on top; it was the discovery that the most wretched life can become rich and inestimable through a rise in temperature— It goes without saying that such a transference could not take place in respect to the ruling orders: the Jews and Christians had their bad manners against them—and when allied to bad manners, strength and passion of soul are repellent and almost disgusting (—I see these bad manners whenever I read the New Testament). One had to be related through lowliness and want to the type of lowly people who spoke here to feel their attraction— How one reacts to the New Testament is a test of whether one has any classical taste in one’s bones (cf. Tacitus); whoever is not revolted by it, whoever does not honestly and profoundly sense something of foeda superstitio in it, something from which one withdraws one’s hand as if to avoid being soiled, does not know what is classical. One must feel about the “cross” as Goethe did—

176 (March-June 1888)

Reaction of the little people:— Love gives the greatest feeling of power. To grasp to what extent not man in general but a certain species of man speaks here. This is to be exhumed more precisely.²⁷ “We are divine through love, we become ‘children of God’; God loves us and wants nothing whatever from us save love”; this means: no morality, obedience, or activity produces that feeling of power that love produces; one does nothing bad from love, one does much more than one would do from obedience and virtue. Here is the happiness of the herd, the feeling of community in great and small things, the living feeling of unity experienced as the sum of the feeling of life. Being helpful and useful and caring for others continually arouses the feeling of power; visible success, the expression of pleasure underlines the feeling of power; pride is not lacking, in the form of community, the abode of God, the “chosen.” What has in fact happened is that man has again experienced an *altération* of personality: this time he calls his feeling of love God. One must picture to oneself what the awakening of such a feeling is like: a kind of ecstasy, a strange language, a “gospel”— it was this novelty that forbade him to ascribe love to himself—: he thought God was walking before him and coming alive within him.— “God descends to man,” one’s “neighbor” is transfigured into a god (in so far as he arouses the feeling of love). Jesus is one’s neighbor as soon as he is conceived as godhead, as a cause of the feeling of power.

177 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The faithful are conscious that they are endlessly indebted to Christianity, and therefore conclude that its originator is a personage of the first rank— This conclusion is false, but it is typical of conclusions drawn by worshipers. Objectively considered, it is possible, first, that they are in error about the value of that for which they are indebted to Christianity: convictions prove nothing in favor of that of which one is convinced; in the case of religions they establish rather a suspicion against it— It is possible, secondly, that the debt to Christianity ought not to be ascribed to its founder but to the finished structure, to the whole thing, the church, etc. The concept “originator” is so ambiguous it can even mean the accidental cause of a movement: the figure of the founder has been enlarged in proportion as the church has grown; but precisely this perspective of worship permits the conclusion that at some time or other this founder was something very uncertain and insecure, in the beginning— Consider with what degree of freedom Paul treats, indeed almost juggles with, the problem of the person of Jesus: someone who died, who was seen again after his death, who was delivered over to death by the Jews— A mere “motif”: he then wrote the music to it— A zero in the beginning.²⁸ 178 (1884) The founder of a religion can be insignificant—a match, no more!

179 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

On the psychological problem of Christianity.— The driving force is: resentment, the popular uprising, the revolt of the underprivileged. (It is otherwise with Buddhism: this is not born out of a resentment movement but fights resentment because it leads to action) This peace party grasps that the renunciation of enmity in thought and deed is a condition of distinction and preservation. Herein lies the psychological difficulty that has hampered the understanding of Christianity: the drive that created it forces one to fight against it as a matter of principle. Only as a peace and innocence party has this insurrectionary movement any possibility of success: it must conquer through extreme mildness, sweetness, softness; it grasps this by instinct— Masterstroke: to deny and condemn the drive whose expression one is, continually to display, by word and deed, the antithesis of this drive—

180 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Pretended youth. One is deceiving oneself if one imagines here a naive and youthful people rising up against an ancient culture; superstition has it that the deeper springs of life gushed forth anew in those classes of the lowliest people where Christianity grew and took root: one understands nothing of the psychology of Christianity if one takes it to be the expression of a newly arisen national youthfulness and racial invigoration. On the contrary: it is a typical form of decadence, the moral hypersensitivity and hysteria of a sick mishmash populace grown weary and aimless. The extraordinary company that here gathered around this master-seducer really belongs wholly in a Russian novel: all the neuroses keep a rendezvous in them—the absence of duties, the instinct that everything is really coming to an end, that nothing is worth while any more, contentment in a *dolce far niente*.²⁹ The power and certainty of the future in the Jewish instinct, its tremendously tough will to exist and to power, lies in its ruling classes: those orders which primitive Christianity raised up are most clearly distinguished by the exhaustion of their instincts. On one hand, one has had enough: on the other, one is content with oneself, in oneself, for oneself.

181 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Christianity as emancipated Judaism (in the same way as a local and racially conditioned nobility at length emancipates itself from these conditions and goes in search of related elements—) As church (community) within the state, as an unpolitical structure; As life, discipline, practice, art of living; As religion of sin (of transgression against God as the only kind of transgression, as the sole cause of suffering in general), with a universal cure for it. There are only sins against God; men shall not judge acts done against men, nor demand a reckoning, except in the name of God. Ditto, all commands (love): everything is associated with God and done to man for God's sake. A higher prudence lies in this (—a very narrow life, as with the Eskimos, is endurable only by the most peaceable and cautious disposition: Jewish-Christian dogma turns against sin in favor of the “sinner”—).

182 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The Jewish priesthood had understood how to present everything which it claimed as a divine precept, as obedience to a command of God—also how to introduce whatever served to preserve Israel and make possible its existence (e.g., a number of works: circumcision, sacrificial cult as the center of national consciousness) not as nature, but as “God.”— This process continued; within Judaism, where the necessity for “works” was not felt (that is to say, as a means of segregation from the outside world), a priestly species of man could be conceived that behaved as the “noble nature” behaves toward the aristocracy; a classless and at the same time spontaneous priestliness of soul, which now, in order to contrast itself sharply with its opposite, attached value not to “works,” but to the “disposition”— Fundamentally it was again the question of making a certain species of soul prevail: as it were, a popular uprising within a priestly people—a pietistic movement from below (sinners, publicans, women, the sick). Jesus of Nazareth was the sign by which they recognized themselves. And again, in order to believe in themselves they need a theological transfiguration: they require nothing less than “the Son of God” to create a faith for themselves— And just as the priesthood had falsified the entire history of Israel, so again the attempt was here made to forge the history of mankind in general, so that Christianity might appear to be its most cardinal event. This movement could have arisen only on the soil of Judaism, whose principal deed was to associate guilt with misfortune and to reduce all guilt to guilt against God: Christianity raised all this to the second power.

183 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The symbolism of Christianity is based on the Jewish, which had already resolved all reality (history, nature) into a holy unnaturalness and unreality—which no longer recognized real history, which was no longer interested in natural consequences—

184 (March-June 1888)

The Jews tried to prevail after they had lost two of their castes, that of the warrior and that of the peasant; in this sense they are the “castrated”: they have the priests—and then immediately the chandala— As is only fair, a break develops among them, a revolt of the chandala: the origin of Christianity. Because they knew the warrior only as their master, they brought into their religion enmity toward the noble, toward the exalted and proud, toward power, toward the ruling orders—: they are pessimists from indignation— Thus they created an important new posture: the priest at the head of the chandala—against the noble orders— Christianity drew the ultimate conclusion of this movement: even in the Jewish priesthood it still sensed caste, the privileged, the noble—it abolished the priest — The Christian is the chandala who repudiates the priest—the chandala who redeems himself— That is why the French Revolution is the daughter and continuation of Christianity—its instincts are against caste, against the noble, against the last privileges——

185 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The “Christian ideal”: staged with Jewish subtlety. The basic psychological drives, its “nature”: the revolt against the ruling spiritual power; attempt to make the virtues through which happiness is possible for the lowliest into the standard ideal of all values—to call it God: the instinct for preservation in the least vital classes; to justify absolute abstention from war and resistance through this ideal—including obedience; love of one another as consequence of love of God.

Artifice: to deny all natural mobilia and to transfer them to the spiritual realm beyond—to exploit virtue and its veneration entirely for one’s own ends, step by step to deny virtue to everything non-Christian.

186 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The profound contempt with which the Christian was treated in the noble areas of classical antiquity is of a kind with the present instinctive aversion to Jews: it is the hatred of the free and self-respecting orders for those who are pushing and who combine timid and awkward gestures with an absurd opinion of their worth. The New Testament is the gospel of a wholly ignoble species of man; their claim to possess more value, indeed to possess all value, actually has something revolting about it—even today.

187 (Spring-Fall 1887)

How little the subject matters! It is the spirit that gives life! What stuffy and sickroom air arises from all that excited chatter about “redemption,” love, blessedness, faith, truth, “eternal life”! Take, on the other hand, a really pagan book, e.g., Petronius, where fundamentally nothing is done, said, desired and valued but what by peevish Christian standards is sin, mortal sin even. And yet how pleasant is the purer air, the superior spirituality of its quicker pace, the liberated and overflowing strength that feels sure of the future! In the entire New Testament there is not one single bouffonnerie: but that fact refutes a book—

188 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The profound unworthiness with which all life outside the Christian life is condemned: they are not content with thinking meanly of their real opponents, they require nothing less than a collective defamation of everything which is not themselves— Arrogance of holiness gets along famously with a base and crafty soul: witness the first Christians. The future: they see they are well paid— Theirs is the most uncleanly kind of spirit there is. The entire life of Christ is so presented as to help to justify the prophecies: he acts in this way in order that they may be justified—

189 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The lying interpretation of the words, gestures and conditions of the dying: fear of death, for example, is systematically confused with fear of the “after death”—
30

190 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The Christians did as the Jews did and put into the mouth of their master and encrusted his life with what they conceived to be a condition of their existence and an innovation. At the same time they restored to him all proverbial wisdom —: in short, they represented their actual life and activity as obedience and thus, as sanctified for their propaganda. What it all depends upon can be gathered from Paul: it is not much. What remains is the elaboration of a type of saint on the basis of what they considered holy. The entire “miraculous doctrine,” including the resurrection, is a consequence of self-glorification by the community, which ascribed to its master in a higher degree whatever it thought itself capable of (it derived its strength from him—).

191 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Christians have never put into practice the acts Jesus prescribed for them, and the impudent chatter about “justification by faith” and its unique and supreme significance is only the consequence of the church’s lack of courage and will to confess the works which Jesus demanded. The Buddhist acts differently from the non-Buddhist; the Christian acts as all the world does and possesses a Christianity of ceremonies and moods. The profound and contemptible mendaciousness of Christianity in Europe—: we really are becoming the contempt of the Arabs, Hindus, Chinese— Listen to the speeches of Germany’s first statesman on what has really occupied Europe for forty years now—listen to the language, the court-chaplain Tartuffery.

192 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

“Faith” or “works”?— But that “works,” the habit of certain works, should engender a certain evaluation and finally a certain disposition is as natural as it is unnatural that mere evaluation should produce “works.” One must practice deeds, not the strengthening of one’s value-feelings; one must first have some ability— The Christian dilettantism of Luther. Faith is a pons asinorum.³¹ The background is a profound conviction on the part of Luther and his kind of their incapacity for Christian works, a personal fact disguised beneath an extreme doubt as to whether activity of all kinds is not sin and the work of the Devil: so that the value of existence resides in single highly tensed conditions of inactivity (prayer, effusion, etc.).— In the last resort he was right: the instincts expressed in all the actions of the Reformers are the most brutal that exist. Only by an absolute turning away from themselves, by absorption in their opposite, only as an illusion (“faith”) was existence endurable to them.

193 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

“What to do in order to believe?”—an absurd question. What is wrong with Christianity is that it refrains from doing all those things that Christ commanded should be done. It is the mean life, but interpreted through the eye of contempt.

194 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Entry into real life—one rescues one's personal life from death by living a common life—

195 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

“Christianity” has become something fundamentally different from what its founder did and desired. It is the great antipagan movement of antiquity, formulated through the employment of the life, teaching and “words” of the founder of Christianity but interpreted in an absolutely arbitrary way after the pattern of fundamentally different needs: translated into the language of every already existing subterranean religion— It is the rise of pessimism (—while Jesus wanted to bring peace and the happiness of lambs) : and moreover the pessimism of the weak, the inferior, the suffering, the oppressed. Its mortal enemy is (1) power in character, spirit and taste; “worldliness”; (2) classical “happiness,” the noble levity and skepticism, the hard pride, the eccentric intemperance and the cool self-sufficiency of the sage, Greek refinement in gesture, word, and form. Its mortal enemy is the Roman just as much as the Greek. Attempt by antipaganism to found and make itself possible philosophically: predilection for the ambiguous figures of the old culture, above all for Plato, that instinctive Semite and anti-Hellene—also for Stoicism, which is essentially the work of Semites (—“dignity” as strictness, law, virtue as greatness, self-responsibility, authority, as supreme sovereignty over one’s own person— this is Semitic. The Stoic is an Arabian sheik wrapped in Greek togas and concepts).³²

196 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Christianity only takes up the fight that had already begun against the classical ideal and the noble religion. In fact, this entire transformation is an adaption to the needs and the level of understanding of the religious masses of that time: those masses which believed in Isis, Mithras, Dionysus, the “Great Mother,” and which desired of a religion: (1) hope of a beyond, (2) the bloody phantasmagoria of the sacrificial animal (the mystery), (3) the redemptive deed, the holy legend, (4) asceticism, world-denial, superstitious “purification,” (5) a hierarchy, a form of community. In short: Christianity accommodated itself to already existing and established antipaganism, to the cults that had been combatted by Epicurus—more precisely, to the religions of the lower masses, the women, the slaves, the non-noble classes. We therefore have the following misunderstandings: the immortality of the person; the presumed other world; the absurdity of the concept of punishment and the concept of sin at the heart of the interpretation of existence; instead of the deification of man his un-deification, the digging of the deepest chasm, which only a miracle, only prostration in deepest self-contempt can bridge; the whole world of corrupt imagination and morbid affects instead of a kindly and simple way of life, instead of a Buddhistic happiness attainable on earth; an ecclesiastical order with priesthood, theology, cult, sacrament; in short, everything that Jesus of Nazareth had combatted; miracles all over, superstition: while the distinguishing mark of Judaism and earliest Christianity is its repugnance to miracles, its relative rationality.

197 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The psychological presupposition: lack of knowledge and culture, ignorance which has forgotten all shame: imagine these impudent saints in Athens; the Jewish instinct of the “chosen”: they claim all the virtues for themselves without further ado, and count the rest of the world their opposites; a profound sign of a vulgar soul; a complete lack of real aims, of real tasks, for which one needs other virtues than those of the bigot—the state took this work from their shoulders: these impudent people nonetheless behaved as if they had no need of the state. “Except ye become as little children—”: oh, how far we are from this psychological naïveté!

198 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The founder of Christianity had to pay for having directed himself to the lowest class of Jewish society and intelligence. They conceived him in the spirit they understood— It is a real disgrace to have concocted a salvation story, a personal God, a personal redeemer, a personal immortality and to have retained all the meanness of the “person” and “history” in a doctrine that contests the reality of all that is personal and historical— The salvation legend in place of the symbolic now-and-always, here and everywhere; the miracle in place of the psychological symbol.

199 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Nothing is less innocent than the New Testament. One knows from what soil it sprang. This people of an inflexible self-will which knew how to prevail after it had lost every natural support and had long since forfeited its right to existence, and to that end had to raise itself up by unnatural, purely imaginary presuppositions (as chosen people, as community of saints, as the people of the promise, as “church”): this people handled the *pia fraus* with such perfection, such a degree of “good conscience,” that one cannot be sufficiently cautious when it preaches morality. When Jews step forward as innocence itself then the danger is great: one should always have one’s little fund of reason, mistrust, and malice to hand when one reads the New Testament. People of the basest origin, in part rabble, outcasts not only from good but also from respectable society, raised away from even the smell of culture, without discipline, without knowledge, without the remotest suspicion that there is such a thing as conscience in spiritual matters; simply—Jews: with an instinctive ability to create an advantage, a means of seduction out of every superstitious supposition, out of ignorance itself.³⁴

200 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. 1888)

I regard Christianity as the most fatal seductive lie that has yet existed, as the great unholy lie: I draw out the after-growth and sprouting of its ideal from beneath every form of disguise, I reject every compromise position with respect to it—I force a war against it. Petty people’s morality as the measure of things: this is the most disgusting degeneration culture has yet exhibited. And this kind of ideal still hanging over mankind as “God”!!

201 (Spring-Fall 1887)

However modest one may be in one's demand for intellectual cleanliness, one cannot help feeling, when coming into contact with the New Testament, a kind of inexpressible discomfiture: for the unchecked impudence with which the least qualified want to raise their voice on the greatest problems, and even claim to be judges of such things, surpasses all measure. The shameless levity with which the most intractable problems (life, world, God, purpose of life) are spoken of, as if they were not problems at all but simply things that these little bigots knew!

202 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

This was the most fatal kind of megalomania there has ever been on earth: when these lying little abortions of bigots began to lay claim to the words “God,” “Last Judgment,” “truth,” “love,” “wisdom,” “Holy Spirit” and with them made a boundary between themselves and “the world”; when this species of man began to reverse values according to his own image, as if he were the meaning, the salt, the measure, and the standard of all the rest—one should have built madhouses for them and nothing more. That one persecuted them was a piece of ancient folly in the grand manner: that meant taking them too seriously, that meant making something serious out of them. The whole fatality was made possible by the presence in the world already of a similar kind of megalomania, the Jewish (—once the chasm had opened up between the Jews and the Christian-Jews, the Christian-Jews had to employ once more and in an ultimate intensification for their own self-preservation the self-preservative procedures devised by the Jewish instinct—); on the other hand, Greek moral philosophy had already done everything to prepare the way for and to make palatable moral fanaticism even among Greeks and Romans—Plato, the great viaduct of corruption, who first refused to see nature in morality, who had already debased the Greek gods with his concept “good,” who was already marked by Jewish bigotry (—in Egypt?)

203 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

On the denaturing of morality.— These little herd-animal virtues do not by any means lead to “eternal life”: to put them on show in this way, and oneself with them, may be very clever, but to him who keeps his eyes open even here, it remains in spite of all the most ludicrous of all plays. One does not by any means deserve a privileged position on earth and in heaven by attaining perfection as a little, good-natured sheep; one remains at best a little, good-natured, absurd sheep with horns—provided one does not burst with vanity—as the court chaplains do—or provoke scandal by posing as a judge. What a tremendous transfiguration of color here illumines the little virtues—as if they were the reflection of divine qualities! The natural task and utility of every virtue is systematically hushed up; it is of value only with reference to a divine command, a divine model, only with reference to heavenly and spiritual goods. (Magnificent: as if it had to do with “salvation of the soul”: but it was a means of “enduring” things here with as many beautiful feelings as possible.)

204 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

The law, the thoroughly realistic formalization of certain conditions for the self-preservation of a community, forbids certain actions directed to certain ends, namely those that are directed against the community: it does not forbid the disposition that produces these actions—for it needs these actions for other ends, namely against the enemies of the community. Then the moral idealist appears and says: “God beholds the heart: the action itself is nothing; one must exterminate the aggressive disposition that produces it—” Under normal conditions one laughs at this; only in those exceptional instances when a community lives absolutely outside the necessity of waging war for its existence does one lend an ear to such things. One abandons a disposition whose utility is no longer apparent. This was the case, e.g., when Buddha appeared amidst a very peaceable and even spiritually exhausted community. This was also the case with the earliest Christian community (also Jewish community), whose presupposition is the absolutely unpolitical Jewish society. Christianity could grow only in the soil of Judaism, i.e., amidst a people that had already renounced politics and lived a kind of parasitic existence within the Roman order of things. Christianity is a step further on: one is even more free to “emasculate” oneself—circumstances permit it. One drives nature out of morality when one says “Love your enemies”: for then the natural “Thou shalt love thy neighbor and hate thy enemy” in the law (in instinct) has become meaningless; then this love of one’s neighbor must also find a new basis (as a kind of love of God). Everywhere, God is inserted and utility withdrawn; everywhere the real origin of morality is denied: the veneration of nature, which lies precisely in the recognition of a natural morality, is destroyed at its roots— Whence comes the seductive charm of such an emasculated ideal of man? Why are we not disgusted by it as we are perhaps disgusted by the idea of a castrato?— The answer lies precisely here: the voice of a castrato does not disgust us, despite the cruel mutilation that is its condition: it has grown sweeter— Just because the “male organ” has been amputated from virtue, a feminine note has been brought to the voice of virtue that it did not have before. If we think, on the other hand, of the fearful hardship, danger, and accidents that a life of manly virtue brings with it—the life of a Corsican even today or that of the pagan Arab (which is similar even in its details to the life of the Corsican: their songs might have been written by Corsicans)— we grasp how precisely the most robust kind of man is fascinated and affected by this lustful note of “goodness,” of “purity”— A shepherd’s song—an idyl—the “good man”: these things produce the strongest effect in ages when tragedy walks abroad. * But we have with this also recognized to what extent the “idealist” (—ideal-castrato) also emerges from a quite definite reality and is not merely a fantasist—he has arrived at the knowledge that for his kind of reality

such a coarse injunction forbidding definite actions has no meaning (because the very instinct for these actions has been weakened through long lack of practice, of need for practice). The castrator formulates a number of new self-preservative measures for men of a quite definite species: in this he is a realist. His means of legislation are the same as those of the older legislators: the appeal to authority of all kinds, to “God,” the employment of the concept “guilt and punishment”—i.e., he makes use of all the appurtenances of the older ideal, only in a new interpretation, punishment, for example, made more inward (perhaps as the pang of conscience). In practice this species of man goes under as soon as the exceptional conditions of his existence cease—a kind of Tahiti and island happiness, as in the life of the little Jews in the provinces. Their only natural opponent is the soil from which they grew: against this they need to fight, against this they must let the offensive and defensive affects grow again: their opponents are the adherents of the old ideal (—this species of enmity is championed on a grand scale by Paul in relation to Judaism, by Luther in relation to the priestly-ascetic ideal). The mildest form of this opposition is certainly that of the early Buddhists: perhaps no greater amount of work has been expended upon anything than upon the discouragement and weakening of feelings of enmity. The fight against resentment seems to be almost the first duty of the Buddhist: only thus is peace of soul assured. To disengage oneself, but without rancor: that presupposes, to be sure, an astonishingly mild and sweet humanity—saints—* The prudence of moral castrationism.— How can one wage war against the manly affects and valuations? One possesses no means of physical force, one can wage only a war of cunning, sorcery, lies, in short “of the spirit.” First recipe: one claims virtue in general for one’s ideal; one negates the older ideal to the point of presenting it as the antithesis of all ideals. For this one employs an art of defamation. Second recipe: one sets up one’s own type as the measure of value in general; one projects it into things, behind things, behind the fate of things—as God. Third recipe: one sets up the opponent of one’s ideal as the opponent of God; one fabricates for oneself the right to great pathos, to power, to curse and to bless. Fourth recipe: one derives all suffering, all that is uncanny, fearful and fateful in existence from opposition to one’s own ideal:—all suffering is punishment, even in the case of one’s followers (—unless it accompanies a test, etc.). Fifth recipe: one goes so far as to conceive nature as the antithesis of one’s own ideal; one regards it as a great test of patience, as a sort of martyrdom to endure natural conditions for very long; one practices *dédain* of mien and manners in respect to all “natural things.” Sixth recipe: the victory of unnaturalness, of the castrationist ideal, the victory of the world of the pure, good, sinless, blessed is projected into the future as conclusion, finale, great

hope, as the “coming of the kingdom of God.” ——I hope that at this artificial inflation of a small species into the absolute measure of things one is still permitted to laugh?

205 (Spring-Fall 1887)

I do not like at all about that Jesus of Nazareth or his apostle Paul that they put so many ideas into the heads of little people, as if their modest virtues were of any consequence. We have had to pay too dearly for it: for they have brought the more valuable qualities of virtue and man into ill repute; they have set the bad conscience of the noble soul against its self-sufficiency; they have led astray, to the point of self-destruction, the brave, magnanimous, daring, excessive inclinations of the strong soul—

206 (Spring-Fall 1887)

In the New Testament, and specifically in the Gospels, I hear absolutely nothing “divine” speaking: much rather an indirect form of the most abysmal rage for defamation and destruction—one of the most dishonorable forms of hatred. It lacks all knowledge of the qualities of a higher nature. Clumsy abuse of all kinds of philistinism; the entire treasury of proverbs is laid claim to and fully utilized; was it necessary for a god to come in order to say to these publicans etc.— Nothing is more vulgar than this battle against the Pharisees with the aid of an absurd and impractical moral pretence; the people have always taken pleasure in such a tour de force. The reproach of “hypocrisy!” coming from this mouth! Nothing is more vulgar than this kind of treatment of an opponent—a most insidious criterion of nobility or its reverse—

207 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Primitive Christianity is abolition of the state: forbids oaths, war service, courts of justice, self-defense and the defense of any kind of community, the distinction between fellow countrymen and foreigners, and also the differentiation of classes. Christ's example: he does not resist those who are harming him; he does not defend himself; he does more: he "turns the other cheek" (to the question: "Tell us whether thou be the Christ" he answers: "Hereafter shall ye see the Son of Man sitting on the right hand of power and coming in the clouds of heaven"). He forbids his disciples to defend him; he makes it clear that he could get help but will not. Christianity is also abolition of society: it prefers all that society counts of little worth, it grows up among outcasts and the condemned, among lepers of all kinds, "sinners," "publicans," prostitutes, the most stupid folk (the "fishers"); it disdains the rich, the learned, the noble, the virtuous, the "correct"—

208 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The war against the noble and powerful as it is waged in the New Testament is a war after the manner of Reynard the Fox and with the same methods: but always with priestly unction and a decided refusal to recognize one's own cunning.

209 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The gospel: the news that a gateway to happiness stands open for the poor and lowly—that all one has to do is free oneself from the institutions, traditions, guardianship of the upper classes: to this extent the rise of Christianity is nothing more than the typical socialist doctrine. Property, gain, fatherland, rank and status, tribunals, police, state, church, education, art, the army: all are so many hindrances to happiness, errors, snares, works of the devil, upon which the gospel passes judgment—all typical of socialist doctrine. In the background is insurrection, the explosion of a stored-up antipathy towards the “masters,” the instinct for how much happiness could lie, after such long oppression, simply in feeling oneself free— (Usually a sign that the lower orders have been too well treated, their tongues have already tasted a happiness forbidden them— It is not hunger that provokes revolutions, but that the people have acquired an appetite en mangeant—).

210 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Read the New Testament as a book of seduction: virtue is appropriated in the instinct that with it one can capture public opinion—and indeed the most modest virtue, which recognizes the ideal sheep and nothing further (including the shepherd—): a little, sweet, well-meaning, helpful, and enthusiastically cheerful kind of virtue that expects absolutely nothing from the outside—that sets itself altogether apart from “the world.” The most absurd arrogance, as if on one hand the community represented all that is right, and on the other the world all that is false, eternally reprehensible, and rejected, and as if the destiny of mankind revolved about this fact. The most absurd hatred toward everything in power: but without touching it! A kind of inner detachment that outwardly leaves everything as it was (servitude and slavery; to know how to turn everything into a means of serving God and virtue).

211 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

Christianity is possible as the most private form of existence; it presupposes a narrow, remote, completely unpolitical society— it belongs in the conventicle. A “Christian state,” “Christian politics,” on the other hand, are a piece of impudence, a lie, like for instance a Christian leadership of an army, which finally treats the “God of Hosts” as if he were chief of staff. The papacy, too, has never been in a position to carry on Christian politics; and when reformers indulge in politics, as Luther did, one sees that they are just as much followers of Machiavelli as any immoralist or tyrant.

212 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Christianity is still possible at any time. It is not tied to any of the impudent dogmas that have adorned themselves with its name: it requires neither the doctrine of a personal God, nor that of sin, nor that of immortality, nor that of redemption, nor that of faith; it has absolutely no need of metaphysics, and even less of asceticism, even less of a Christian “natural science.” Christianity is a way of life, not a system of beliefs. It tell us how to act, not what we ought to believe. Whoever says today: “I will not be a soldier,” “I care nothing for the courts,” “I shall not claim the services of the police,” “I will do nothing that may disturb the peace within me: and if I must suffer on that account, nothing will serve better to maintain my peace than suffering”—he would be a Christian.³⁸

213 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Toward a history of Christianity. Continual change of milieu: Christian doctrine is therefore continually changing its emphasis— Favoring of lowly and little people— The development of caritas— The type “Christian” reassumes step by step everything that it originally negated (in the negation of which it endured—). The Christian becomes citizen, soldier, judge, worker, merchant, scholar, theologian, priest, philosopher, farmer, artist, patriot, politician, “prince”—he takes up again all the activities he has forsworn (—self-defense, judgment, punishment, oath-taking, distinguishing between nation and nation, contempt, wrath—). The whole life of the Christian is at last exactly the life from which Christ preached deliverance— The church is what is as much a symptom of the triumph of the anti-Christian as the modern state, modern nationalism— The church is the barbarization of Christianity.

214 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

These have mastered Christianity: Judaism (Paul); Platonism (Augustine); the mystery cult (doctrine of redemption, emblem of the “cross”); asceticism (—enmity toward “nature,” “reason,” “the senses”—the Orient—).

215 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Christianity as a denaturalization of herd-animal morality: accompanied by absolute misunderstanding and self-deception. Democratization is a more natural form of it, one less mendacious. Datum: the oppressed, the lowly, the great masses of slaves and semi-slaves desire power. First step: they make themselves free—they ransom themselves, in imagination at first, they recognize one another, they prevail. Second step: they enter into battle, they demand recognition, equal rights, “justice.” Third step: they demand privileges (—they draw the representatives of power over to their side). Fourth step: they demand exclusive power, and they get it— In Christianity, three elements must be distinguished: (a) the oppressed of all kinds, (b) the mediocre of all kinds, (c) the discontented and sick of all kinds. With the first element Christianity fights against the political nobility and its ideal; with the second element, against the exceptional and privileged (spiritually, physically—) of all kinds; with the third element, against the natural instinct of the healthy and happy. When a victory is won, the second element steps into the foreground; for then Christianity has persuaded the healthy and happy to its side (as warriors in its cause), likewise the powerful (as interested parties on account of the conquest of the mob)—and now it is the herd instinct, the mediocre nature which is of value from any point of view, which gets its supreme sanction through Christianity. This mediocre nature at last grows so conscious of itself (—acquires courage for itself—) that it arrogates even political power to itself— Democracy is Christianity made natural: a kind of “return to nature” after, on account of its extreme antinaturalness, it could be overcome by the opposite values.— Consequence: the aristocratic ideal henceforth loses its naturalness (“the higher man,” “noble,” “artist,” “passion,” “knowledge,” etc.; romanticism as cult of the exception, the genius, etc.).

216 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

When the “masters” could also become Christians.— It lies in the instinct of a community (family, race, herd, tribe) to feel that the conditions and desires to which it owes its survival are valuable in themselves, e.g., obedience, reciprocity, consideration, moderation, sympathy—consequently to suppress everything that contradicts or stands in the way of them. Likewise, it lies in the instinct of the rulers (be they individuals or classes) to patronize and applaud the virtues that make their subjects useful and submissive (—conditions and affects which may be as different as can be from their own). The herd instinct and the instinct of the rulers agree in praising a certain number of qualities and conditions—but for differing reasons: the former from direct egoism, the latter from indirect egoism. Submission of the master races to Christianity is essentially the consequence of the insight that Christianity is a herd religion, that it teaches obedience: in short, that Christians are easier to rule than non-Christians. With this hint, the pope recommends Christian propaganda to the emperor of China even today. It should be added that the seductive force of the Christian ideal works most strongly perhaps upon such natures as love danger, adventure and opposition—as love all that involves risking themselves while at the same time engendering a non plus ultra of the feeling of power. Consider Saint Teresa, surrounded by the heroic instincts of her brothers:— Christianity here appears as a form of orgy of the will, of strength of will, as a heroic quixotism—

217 (Spring-Fall 1887)

War against the Christian ideal, against the doctrine of “blessedness” and “salvation” as the goal of life, against the supremacy of the simple, the pure in heart, the suffering and unfortunate.⁴⁰ When and where has any man of consequence resembled the Christian ideal—at least in such eyes as a psychologist and student of man must have?—check all of Plutarch’s heroes.

218 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Our pre-eminence: we live in the age of comparison, we can verify as has never been verified before: we are in every way the self-consciousness of history. We enjoy differently, we suffer differently: our instinctive activity is to compare an unheard-of number of things. We understand everything, we experience everything, we no longer have in us any hostile feelings. Although we may harm ourselves by it, our importunate and almost amorous inquisitiveness attacks, unabashed, the most dangerous things— “Everything is good”—it requires an effort for us to deny anything We suffer if we should happen to be so unintelligent as to take sides against anything— Fundamentally, it is we scholars who today best fulfill the teaching of Christ— 219 (1885-1886) Irony against those who believe Christianity has been overcome by the modern natural sciences. Christian value judgments have not by any means been overcome this way. “Christ on the cross” is the most sublime symbol—even today.

220 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The two great nihilistic movements: (a) Buddhism, (b) Christianity. The latter has only now attained to approximately the state of culture in which it can fulfill its original vocation—a level to which it belongs—in which it can show itself pure.

221 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

We have recovered the Christian ideal: it remains to determine its value: What values are negated by it? What does its counterideal comprise?—Pride, pathos of distance, great responsibility, exuberance, splendid animality, the instincts that delight in war and conquest, the deification of passion, of revenge, of cunning, of anger, of voluptuousness, of adventure, of knowledge—; the noble ideal is negated: the beauty, wisdom, power, splendor and dangerousness of the type “man”: the man who fixes goals, the “man of the future” (—here Christianity appears as a logical consequence of Judaism—). Can it be realized?—Yes, under the right climatic conditions, as the Indian ideal was. Work is missing in both.—It detaches the individual from people, state, cultural community, jurisdiction; it rejects education, knowledge, cultivation of good manners, gain, commerce—it lets everything go that comprises the usefulness and value of man—it shuts him off by means of an idiosyncrasy of feeling. Unpolitical, antinational, neither aggressive nor defensive—possible only within the most firmly ordered political and social life, which allows these holy parasites to proliferate at public expense — It is a consequence of the will to pleasure—and to nothing else! “Blessedness” counts as something self-evident, which no longer requires any justification—everything else (how to live and let live) is only a means to an end — But this way of thinking is base: fear of pain, of defilement, of corruption as a sufficient motive for letting everything go— This is a wretched way of thinking — Sign of an exhausted race— One should not let oneself be deceived. (“Become as little children”—. Of related nature: Francis of Assisi, neurotic, epileptic, a visionary, like Jesus.)

222 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The higher man is distinguished from the lower by his fearlessness and his readiness to challenge misfortune: it is a sign of degeneration when eudaemonistic valuations begin to prevail (—physiological fatigue, feebleness of will—). Christianity, with its perspective of “blessedness,” is a mode of thought typical of a suffering and feeble species of man. Abundant strength wants to create, suffer, go under: the Christian salvation-for-bigots is bad music to it, and its hieratic posture an annoyance. 223 (1885-1886) Poverty, humility, and chastity—dangerous and slanderous ideals, but, like poisons in the case of certain illnesses, useful cures, e.g, in the Roman imperial era. All ideals are dangerous: because they debase and brand the actual; all are poisons, but indispensable as temporary cures.

224 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

God created man happy, idle, innocent, and immortal: our actual life is a false, decayed, sinful existence, an existence of punishment—Suffering, struggle, work, death are considered as objections and question marks against life, as something that ought not to last; for which one requires a cure—and has a cure! — From the time of Adam until now, man has been in an abnormal state: God himself has sacrificed his son for the guilt of Adam, in order to put an end to this abnormal state: the natural character of life is a curse; Christ gives back the state of normality to him who believes in him: he makes him happy, idle and innocent. — But the earth has not begun to be fruitful without work; women do not bear children without pain; sickness has not ceased; the most devout believers have just as hard a time of it here as the least devout unbelievers. That man has been freed from death and sin (assertions which permit of no verification)—has been asserted by the church with all the more emphasis. “He is free from sin”—not through his own deed, not through a stern struggle on his part, but ransomed for freedom through the act of redemption—consequently perfect, innocent, paradisiacal—The true life is only a faith (i.e., a self-deception, a madness). The whole of struggling, battling, actual existence, full of splendor and darkness, only a bad, false existence: the task is to be redeemed from it. “Man innocent, idle, immortal, happy”—this conception of “supreme desiderata” must be criticized above all. Why are guilt, work, death, suffering (and, from a Christian viewpoint, knowledge—) contrary to the supreme desiderata?—The lazy Christian concepts “blessedness,” “innocence,” “immortality”—

225 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The eccentric concept of “holiness” is lacking—“God” and “man” have not been torn asunder. “Miracles” are lacking—this sphere simply isn’t there: the only sphere worth consideration is the “spiritual” (i.e., the symbolic-psychological). As decadence: pendant to “epicureanism”—Paradise, as conceived by the Greeks, also only the “garden of Epicurus.” Any task is lacking in such a life:—it desires nothing; a form of the “Epicurean gods;” all reason is lacking to set up any further goals, to have children:— everything has been attained.

226 (March-June 1888)

They despised the body: they left it out of the account: more, they treated it as an enemy. It was their delusion to believe that one could carry a “beautiful soul” about in a cadaverous abortion— To make this conceivable to others they needed to present the concept “beautiful soul” in a different way, to revalue the natural value, until at last a pale, sickly, idiotically fanatical creature was thought to be perfection, “angelic,” transfiguration, higher man.

227 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Ignorance in psychologicis—the Christian has no nervous system—; contempt for, and a deliberate desire to disregard the demands of the body, the discovery of the body; the presupposition that this is in accordance with the higher nature of man, that it must necessarily be good for the soul; the systematic reduction of all bodily feelings to moral values; illness itself conceived as morally conditioned, perhaps as punishment or as testing or also as a state of salvation in which man becomes more perfect than he could be if he were healthy (—Pascal’s idea); under certain circumstances, making oneself sick deliberately. 228 (1883-1888) What, then, is this struggle of the Christian “against nature”? Do not let us be deceived by his words and explanations! It is nature against something that is also nature. With many it is fear, with some disgust, with others a certain spirituality, with the best, love of an ideal without flesh and desires, of an “abstraction from nature”—these try to live up to their ideal. It goes without saying that humility in place of self-reliance, anxious circumspection toward the desires, liberation from normal duties (whereby a higher feeling of rank is re-created), the incitement of a continual war over tremendous things, habituation to effusions of feeling— all this composes a type: in this type the excitability of a degenerate body predominates, but this nervousness and the inspirations it induces are interpreted otherwise. The taste of natures of this kind tends (1) to subtlety, (2) to floweriness, (3) to extreme feelings. Natural inclinations are satisfied, but under a new form of interpretation, e.g., as “justification before God,” “the feeling of redemption through grace” (—every undeniable pleasant feeling is interpreted thus!—), pride, voluptuousness, etc. General problem: what will become of the man who defames the natural, and denies and degrades it in practice? In fact, the Christian proves himself to be an exaggerated form of self-control: in order to restrain his desires he seems to find it necessary to extirpate or crucify them.

229 (March-June 1888)

Through the long succession of millennia, man has not known himself physiologically: he does not know himself even today. To know, e.g., that one has a nervous system (—but no “soul”—) is still the privilege of the best informed. But man is not content not to know in this case. One must be very humane to say “I don’t know that,” to afford ignorance. If he is suffering or in a good mood, he has no doubt that he can find the reason for it if only he looks. So he looks for the reason— In truth, he cannot find the reason, because he does not even suspect where he ought to look for it— What happens?— He takes a consequence of his condition for its cause; e.g., a work undertaken in a good mood (really undertaken because the good mood had provided the courage for it) succeeds: ecco, the work is the reason for the good mood.— In fact, the success was determined by the same thing that determined the good mood—by the happy coordination of physiological forces and systems. He feels ill: and consequently he has not got over some worry, some scruple, some self-criticism.— In truth, the man believes his ill condition is a consequence of his scruple, his “sin,” his “self-criticism”— But the condition of recovery returns, often after a profound exhaustion and prostration. “How is it possible for me to feel so free, so redeemed? It is a miracle; only a god can have performed that.”— Conclusion: “He has forgiven me my sin”— From this there follows a certain practice: to excite feelings of sin, to prepare the way for contrition, one has to reduce the body to a morbid and nervous condition. The method of doing this is well known. As one might expect, there is no suspicion of the causal logic of the case: there is a religious interpretation of the mortification of the flesh, it seems an end in itself, whereas it is only a means of making possible the morbid indigestion of repentance (the “*idée fixe*” of sin, the hypnotizing of the hen by the chalk line “sin”). The maltreatment of the body prepares the ground for the sequence of “feelings of guilt,” i.e., a general state of suffering that demands an explanation — On the other hand, the method of “redemption” follows in the same way: one provokes all kinds of orgies of feeling by prayers, motions, gestures, oaths— exhaustion follows, often abruptly, often in the form of epilepsy. And—after a condition of deep somnolence comes the appearance of recovery—in religious language: “redemption.”^{40a}

230 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Formerly one considered these conditions and consequences of physiological exhaustion more important than conditions of health and their consequences, because they are rich in the sudden, the fearful, the inexplicable and the incalculable. One was afraid: one postulated here a higher world. Sleep and dream, shadows, the night, natural terrors, have been held responsible for the creation of two worlds: above all, the symptoms of physiological exhaustion should have been considered in this regard. The ancient religions actually disciplined the pious into a condition of exhaustion in which they must experience such things— One believed one had entered a higher order of things where everything ceased to be familiar.— The appearance of a higher power—

231 (March-June 1888)

Sleep as consequence of every exhaustion, exhaustion as consequence of every excessive excitement— The necessity for sleep, the deification and adoration of the very concept “sleep” in all pessimistic religions and philosophies— The exhaustion is in this case a racial exhaustion: sleep, regarded psychologically, is only a symbol of a much deeper and longer compulsion to rest— In practice it is death that works so seductively behind the image of its brother, sleep—

232 (March-June 1888)

The entire Christian training in repentance and redemption can be conceived as a deliberately provoked folie circulaire:⁴¹ but, as one might expect, producible only in predestined, that is, morbidly inclined individuals.

233 (March-June 1888)

Against remorse and the purely psychological treatment of it.— To be unable to have done with an experience is already a sign of decadence. This reopening of old wounds, this wallowing in self-contempt and contrition, is one more illness, out of which no “salvation of the soul” can arise but only a new form of soul sickness— These “states of redemption” in the Christian are mere variations of one and the same diseased state—interpretations of the epileptic crisis by a certain formula supplied, not by science, but by religious delusion. One is good in a sickly manner when one is sick— We now count the greater part of the psychological apparatus with which Christianity operated as forms of hysteria and epilepsy. The entire practice of psychological healing must be put back on to a physiological basis: the “bite” of conscience as such is a hindrance to recovery—one must try to counterbalance it all by new activities, in order to escape from the sickness of self-torture as quickly as possible— One should discredit the purely psychological practice of the church and the sects as harmful to health— One cannot cure an invalid by prayers and the exorcizing of evil spirits: the conditions of “repose” that supervene under the influence of such things are very far from inspiring confidence, in a psychological sense— One is healthy when one can laugh at the earnestness and zeal with which one has been hypnotized by any single detail of our life, when one feels that the “bite” of conscience is like a dog biting on a stone—when one is ashamed of one’s remorse— Previous practice, which was purely religious and psychological, aimed only at a change in the symptoms: it held a man to be cured when he abased himself before the cross and swore to be a good man— But a criminal who with a certain sombre seriousness cleaves to his fate and does not slander his deed after it is done has more health of soul— The criminals among whom Dostoevsky lived in prison were one and all unbroken natures—are they not worth a hundred times more than a “broken” Christian? (—I recommend that the “bite” of conscience be treated with Mitchell’s cure—) 234 (1883-1888) The “bite” of conscience: sign that the character is not equal to the deed. There is such a thing as a “bite” of conscience after good works: the unfamiliar in them, that which raises them out of the old milieu.—43

235 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

Against remorse.— I do not like this kind of cowardice toward one's own deeds; one should not leave oneself in the lurch at the onset of unanticipated shame and embarrassment. An extreme pride, rather, is in order. After all, what is the good of it! No deed can be undone by being regretted; no more than by being "forgiven" or "atoned for." One would have to be a theologian to believe in a power that annuls guilt: we immoralists prefer not to believe in "guilt." We hold instead that every action is of identical value at root—and that actions that turn against us may, economically considered, be nonetheless useful, generally desirable actions. In any particular case we will allow that an act could easily have been spared us—but circumstances favored it. Which of us, if favored by circumstance, would not have gone through the entire gamut of crime? One should never say on that account: "You should not have done this or that," but always: "How strange that I should not have done that a hundred times before!" After all, very few actions are typical actions and real epitomes of a personality; and considering how little personality most men have, a man is seldom characterized by a single action. Acts of circumstance, merely epidermal, merely reflexes that respond to a stimulus: long before the depths of our being are touched by it, consulted about it. A rage, a reach, a knife thrust: what of personality is in that?⁴⁵ A deed often brings with it a numbness and lack of freedom: so that the doer is as if spellbound at its recollection and feels as if he were an accessory of it. This spiritual disorder, a form of hypnotism, must be resisted at all cost: a single deed, whatever it may be, is, in comparison with everything one has done, a zero, and may be deducted without falsifying the account. The iniquitous interest that society may have in treating our entire existence from a single point of view, as if its meaning lay in bringing forth one single deed, should not infect the doer himself: unfortunately this happens almost all the time. That stems from the fact that a spiritual disturbance follows every deed with unusual consequences, whether these consequences are good or ill. Observe a lover who has received a promise, or a poet applauded by an audience: so far as torpor intellectualis is concerned, they differ in no way from an anarchist confronted with a search warrant. There are actions which are unworthy of us: actions that, if regarded as typical, would reduce us to a lower class of man. Here one has only to avoid the error of regarding them as typical. There are other kinds of actions of which we are unworthy: exceptions born of a particular abundance of happiness and health, our highest floodtide driven so high for once by a storm, an accident: such actions and "works" are likewise not typical. One should never measure an artist by the standard of his works.

236 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

a. In proportion as Christianity still seems necessary today, man is still savage and fateful— b. From another point of view it is not necessary, but extremely harmful, although enticing and seductive because it corresponds to the morbid character of whole classes, whole types of contemporary humanity—decadents of all kinds, they follow their inclinations when they aspire to Christianity— One must distinguish clearly between a. and b. In case a. Christianity is a cure, at least a means of taming (—under certain circumstances it serves to make sick: which can be useful in breaking savagery and brutality). In case b. it is itself a symptom of sickness, propagates decadence; here it works against a corroborating system of treatment, here it is the invalid's instinct against that which is good for him—

237 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The party of the serious, dignified, reflective: and opposed to them the savage, unclean, incalculable beast—: merely a problem of animal taming—in which the animal tamer must be hard, fearsome and terror-inspiring toward his beasts. All essential demands must be made with a brutal clarity, i e, exaggerated a thousandfold: even the fulfilment of the demand must be represented in a coarsened way, so it may inspire awe, e g, emancipation from the senses on the part of the Brahmins. * The struggle with the canaille and the cattle. If a certain taming and order is to be achieved, the chasm between these purified and reborn people and the remainder must be made as fearful as possible— This chasm increases in the higher castes their self-regard, their faith in that which they represent—hence the chandala. Contempt and an excess of it is perfectly correct psychologically, that is to say, exaggerated a hundredfold, so that it may at least be copied.⁴⁶

238 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The struggle against the brutal instincts is different from the struggle against the sick instincts; to make sick may even be a means of mastering brutality. Christian psychological practice often leads to the conversion of a brute into a sick and consequently tame animal. The struggle against brutal and savage natures must be a struggle using means that affect them: superstitions are indispensable and essential—47

239 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Our age is in a certain sense ripe (that is to say, decadent), as the age of Buddha was— Therefore a Christianity is possible, but without the absurd dogmas (the most repellent abortions of antique hybridism). 240 (1885-1886) Even granted that the Christian faith might not be disprovable, Pascal thinks, nonetheless, that, in view of a fearful possibility that it is true, it is in the highest degree prudent to be a Christian. Today one finds, as a sign of how much Christianity has declined in fearfulness, that other attempt to justify it by saying that even if it were an error, one might yet have during one's life the great advantage and enjoyment of this error:— it therefore seems that this faith ought to be maintained precisely for the sake of its tranquilizing effect—not, therefore, from fear of a threatening possibility, rather from fear of a life that has lost one charm. This hedonistic turn, the proof from pleasure, is a symptom of decline: it replaces the proof from strength, from that which overpowers us in the Christian idea, from fear. In fact, with this reinterpretation Christianity is approaching exhaustion: one is content with an opiate Christianity because one has the strength neither to seek, to struggle, to dare, to wish to stand alone, nor for Pascalism, for this brooding self-contempt, for faith in human unworthiness, for the anguished feeling that one is “perhaps damned.” But a Christianity intended above all to soothe diseased nerves has really no need of that fearful solution of a “God on the cross”: which is why Buddhism is silently gaining ground everywhere in Europe.

241 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The humor of European culture: one holds this to be true but does that. E g., what is the point of the arts of reading and criticism as long as the ecclesiastical interpretation of the Bible, Protestant as well as Catholic, is cultivated as ever?

242 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

One does not consider closely enough how barbarous the concepts are by which we Europeans still live. That men have been capable of believing that “salvation of the soul” depended on a book!— And they tell me this is still believed today. What is the point of scientific education, criticism and hermeneutics if such a lunatic exposition of the Bible as is still cultivated by the church has not yet turned the blush of shame into a permanent skin color?

243 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

To consider: to what extent the fateful belief in divine providence—the most paralyzing belief for hand and reason there has ever been—still exists; to what extent Christian presuppositions and interpretations still live on under the formulas “nature,” “progress,” “perfectibility,” “Darwinism,” under the superstitious belief in a certain relationship between happiness and virtue, unhappiness and guilt. That absurd trust in the course of things, in “life,” in the “instinct of life,” that comfortable resignation that comes from the faith that if everyone only does his duty all will be well—this kind of thing is meaningful only by supposing a direction of things *sub specie boni*. Even fatalism, the form philosophical sensibility assumes with us today, is a consequence of this long belief in divine dispensation, an unconscious consequence: as if what happens were no responsibility of ours (—as though it were permissible to let things take their course: every individual self only a mode of absolute reality—).

244 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

It is the height of psychological mendaciousness in man to frame according to his own petty standard of what seems good, wise, powerful, valuable, a being that is an origin and “in-itself”—and therewith to abolish in his mind the entire causal process by means of which any kind of goodness, any kind of wisdom, any kind of power exists and possesses value. In short, to posit elements of the most recent and contingent origin as not created but “in-themselves” and perhaps even as the cause of creation in general—Judging from experience, from every instance in which a man has raised himself significantly above the average of humanity, we see that every high degree of power involves freedom from good and evil and from “true” and “false,” and cannot take into account the demands of goodness: we see that the same applies to every high degree of wisdom—goodness is abrogated in it as much as veracity, justice, virtue, and other popular fancies in valuation. Finally, every high degree of goodness itself: is it not patent that it presupposes a spiritual myopia and coarseness? including the inability to distinguish at a distance between true and false, between useful and harmful? not to discuss the fact that a high degree of power in the hands of the highest degree of goodness would lead to the most calamitous consequences (“the abolition of evil”)?—In fact, one needs only to see what tendencies the “God of love” inspires in his believers: they ruin mankind for the sake of the “good.”—In practice, the actual constitution of the world has shown this same God to be the God of the extremest shortsightedness, devilry and impotence: which reveals how much value there is in this conception of him. Knowledge and wisdom in themselves have no value; no more than goodness: one must first be in possession of the goal from which these qualities derive their value or nonvalue—there could be a goal in the light of which great knowledge might represent a great disvalue (if, for instance, a high degree of deception were one of the prerequisites of the enhancement of life; likewise if goodness were perhaps able to paralyze and discourage the springs of the great longing)—Taking our human life as it is, all “truth,” all “goodness,” all “holiness,” all “divinity” in the Christian style has up to now shown itself to be highly dangerous—even now mankind is in danger of perishing through an idealism inimical of life.⁴⁸

245 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Consider the damage all human institutions sustain if a divine and transcendent higher sphere is postulated that must first sanction these institutions. By then growing accustomed to seeing their value in this sanction (e.g., in the case of marriage), one has reduced their natural dignity, in certain circumstances denied it— Nature has been ill-judged to the extent to which one has brought into honor the antinaturalness of a God. “Natural” has come to mean the same as “contemptible,” “bad”— The fatefulness of a belief in God as the reality of the highest moral qualities: all actual values were therewith denied and systematically conceived as non-values. Thus antinaturalness assumed the throne. With relentless logic one arrived at the absolute demand to deny nature.

246 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

In moving the doctrine of selflessness and love into the foreground, Christianity was in no way establishing the interests of the species as of higher value than the interests of the individual. Its real historical effect, the fateful element in its effect, remains, on the contrary, in precisely the enhancement of egoism, of the egoism of the individual, to an extreme (—to the extreme of individual immortality). Through Christianity, the individual was made so important, so absolute, that he could no longer be sacrificed: but the species endures only through human sacrifice— All “souls” became equal before God: but this is precisely the most dangerous of all possible evaluations! If one regards individuals as equal, one calls the species into question, one encourages a way of life that leads to the ruin of the species: Christianity is the counterprinciple to the principle of selection. If the degenerate and sick (“the Christian”) is to be accorded the same value as the healthy (“the pagan”), or even more value, as in Pascal’s judgment concerning sickness and health, then unnaturalness becomes law— This universal love of men is in practice the preference for the suffering, underprivileged, degenerate: it has in fact lowered and weakened the strength, the responsibility, the lofty duty to sacrifice men. All that remains, according to the Christian scheme of values, is to sacrifice oneself: but this residue of human sacrifice that Christianity concedes and even advises has, from the standpoint of general breeding, no meaning at all. The prosperity of the species is unaffected by the self-sacrifice of this or that individual (—whether it be in the monkish and ascetic manner or, with the aid of crosses, pyres, and scaffolds, as “martyrs” of error). The species requires that the ill-constituted, weak, degenerate, perish: but it was precisely to them that Christianity turned as a conserving force; it further enhanced that instinct in the weak, already so powerful, to take care of and preserve themselves and to sustain one another. What is “virtue” and “charity” in Christianity if not just this mutual preservation, this solidarity of the weak, this hampering of selection? What is Christian altruism if not the mass-egoism of the weak, which divines that if all care for one another each individual will be preserved as long as possible?— If one does not feel such a disposition as an extreme immorality, as a crime against life, one belongs with the company of the sick and possesses its instincts oneself— Genuine charity demands sacrifice for the good of the species—it is hard, it is full of self-overcoming, because it needs human sacrifice. And this pseudo humaneness called Christianity wants it established that no one should be sacrificed—

247 (March-June 1888)

Nothing would be more useful or more to be encouraged than a thoroughgoing practical nihilism. As I understand all the phenomena of Christianity and pessimism, they say: "We are ripe for nonexistence; for us it is reasonable not to exist." This language of "reason" is also, in this case, the language of selective nature. What, on the other hand, is to be condemned in the sternest terms is the ambiguous and cowardly compromise of a religion such as Christianity: more precisely, such as the church: which, instead of encouraging death and self-destruction, protects everything ill-constituted and sick and makes it propagate itself— Problem: with what means could one attain to a severe form of really contagious nihilism: such as teaches and practices voluntary death with scientific conscientiousness (—and not a feeble, vegetable existence in expectation of a false afterlife—)? One cannot sufficiently condemn Christianity for having devaluated the value of such a great purifying nihilistic movement, which was perhaps already being formed, through the idea of the immortal private person: likewise through the hope of resurrection: in short, through continual deterrence from the deed of nihilism, which is suicide— It substituted slow suicide: gradually a petty, poor, but durable life; gradually a quite ordinary, bourgeois, mediocre life, etc.

248 (March-June 1888)

Christian moral quackery.— Pity and contempt succeed one another in quick alternation, and occasionally I get enraged, as at the sight of some mean crime. Here error is made a duty—a virtue; blundering is made into an art, the instinct for destruction systematized as “redemption”; here every operation becomes an injury, an amputation even of those organs whose energy is a precondition of any return to health. And the most that is achieved is never healing, but only the substitution of one set of evil symptoms for another— And this dangerous nonsense, this systematized disfiguring and castration of life, is counted holy, inviolable; to live in its service, to be an instrument of this healing art, to be a priest, makes one distinguished, venerable, makes one holy and even inviolable. Only divinity can be the author of this highest healing art: only as revelation can redemption be understood, as an art of grace, as the most undeserved gift granted to the creature. First proposition: health of soul is regarded as sickness, as suspicious— Second proposition: the prerequisites of a strong and flourishing life, strong desires and passions, count as objections to a strong and flourishing life. Third proposition: all that threatens man with danger, all that might master and destroy him, is evil, is reprehensible—is to be torn from his soul by its roots. Fourth proposition: man made harmless to himself and others, weak, prostrated in humility and modesty, conscious of his weakness, the “sinner”—this is the most desirable type, and one that can also be produced with a little surgery to the soul—

249 (Spring-Fall 1887)

What is it I protest against? That one should take this petty, peaceable mediocrity, this equilibrium of a soul that knows nothing of the mighty motivation of great accumulations of strength, for something exalted, possibly even for the measure of man. Bacon of Verulam says: *Infimarum virtutum apud vulgus laus est, mediarum admiratio, supremarum sensus nullus.*⁴⁹ Christianity, however, belongs, as a religion, to the vulgus: it has no feeling for the highest species of *virtus*.

250 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Let us see what “the true Christian” does with all that which his instinct opposes: —he sullies and suspects the beautiful, the splendid, the rich, the proud, the self-reliant, the knowledgeable, the powerful—in summa, the whole of culture: his object is to deprive it of a good conscience—

251 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Hitherto one has always attacked Christianity not merely in a modest way but in the wrong way. As long as one has not felt Christian morality to be a capital crime against life its defenders have had it all their own way. The question of the mere “truth” of Christianity—whether in regard to the existence of its God or the historicity of the legend of its origin, not to speak of Christian astronomy and natural science—is a matter of secondary importance as long as the question of the value of Christian morality is not considered. Is Christian morality worth anything, or is it a shame and disgrace despite all the holiness of its arts of seduction? The problem of truth can slip away into hiding places of all kinds; and the greatest believers may finally avail themselves of the logic of the greatest unbelievers to create for themselves a right to affirm certain things as irrefutable—namely, as beyond the means of all refutation—(this artifice is today called “Kantian Criticism”).

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One should never forgive Christianity for having destroyed such men as Pascal. One should never cease from combating just this in Christianity: its will to break precisely the strongest and noblest souls. One should never rest as long as this one thing has not been utterly and completely destroyed: the ideal of man invented by Christianity, its demands upon men, its Yes and its No with regard to men. The whole absurd residue of Christian fable, conceptual cobweb-spinning and theology does not concern us; it could be a thousand times more absurd and we would not lift a finger against it. But we do combat the ideal that, with its morbid beauty and feminine seductiveness, with its furtive slanderous eloquence appeals to all the cowardices and vanities of wearied souls—and the strongest have their weary hours—as if all that might, in such states, seem most useful and desirable—trust, guilelessness, modesty, patience, love of one’s fellows, resignation, submission to God, a sort of unharnessing and abdication of one’s whole ego—were also the most useful and desirable as such; as if the petty, modest abortion of a soul, the virtuous average-and-herd man, did not only take precedence over the stronger, more evil, covetous, defiant, prodigal, and therefore a hundred times more imperiled kind of man, but provided nothing less than the ideal, the goal, the measure, the highest desideratum for mankind in general. To erect this ideal was the most sinister temptation ever placed before mankind: for with it, the more strongly constituted exceptions and fortunate cases among men, in whom the will to power and to the growth of the whole type “man” took a step forward, were threatened with destruction; with the values of this ideal, the growth of these higher men, who for the sake of their superior claims and tasks also freely accept a life more full of peril (expressed economically: a rise in the cost of the undertaking in proportion to the decline in the probability of its success) would be attacked at the roots. What is it we combat in Christianity? That it wants to break the strong, that it wants to discourage their courage, exploit their bad hours and their occasional weariness, convert their proud assurance into unease and distress of conscience, that it knows how to poison and sicken the noble instincts until their strength, their will to power turns backward, against itself—until the strong perish through orgies of self-contempt and self-abuse: that gruesome way of perishing of which Pascal provides the most famous example. This section must be taken in the context of the immediately preceding sections and should be compared with the chapters on “The ‘Improvers’ of Mankind” in *Twilight* (p 501, *Portable Nietzsche*), and with *The Antichrist* (p. 565, *Portable Nietzsche*), both of which were written later. See also my preface to *The Antichrist* in *The Portable Nietzsche* and Chapter 10, “The Master-Race,” and Chapter 7, section III, in my *Nietzsche. Schlechta*, of course, reproduces the text of the standard editions, ignoring 1911, p. 501. 24 I

Corinthians 13. The point Nietzsche makes here was utterly revolutionary at that time and constitutes a major contribution to our understanding of Judaism and Christianity, even if the form of expression here is deliberately hyperbolic and paradoxical. For further discussion, see my Nietzsche, Chapter 12, section II. 25 “Abominable superstition.” 40a This discussion of mistaking consequences for causes should be compared with the chapter on “The Four Great Errors” in Twilight. The influence of these passages and others on Sartre’s *The Flies* is discussed in detail in my essay on “Nietzsche between Homer and Sartre: Five Treatments of the Orestes Story,” in *Révue Internationale de Philosophie*, 67 (1964.1), especially pp. 65-73. II. CRITIQUE OF MORALITY 253 (1885-1886) For the Preface of *The Dawn* An attempt to think about morality without falling under its spell, mistrustful of the seductiveness of its beautiful gestures and glances. A world we can revere, that is adequate to our drive to worship—that continually proves itself—by providing guidance in the particular and the general —: this is the Christian viewpoint in which we have all grown up. Through an increase in our acuteness, mistrust, scientificity (also through a more ambitious instinct for veracity, thus under anti-Christian influences), this interpretation has grown more and more impermissible to us. Subtlest way of escape: Kantian Criticism. The intellect disputes its right to make interpretations of this sort as well as to reject interpretations of this sort. One contents oneself with an increase in one’s trust and faith, with a renunciation of all provability in matters of faith, with an inconceivable and superior “ideal” (God) as a stopgap. The Hegelian way out, following Plato, a piece of romanticism and reaction, at the same time a symptom of the historical sense, of a new strength: the “spirit” itself is the “self-revealing and self-realizing ideal”: more and more of this ideal in which we believe manifests itself in the course of its “process,” in “becoming”—: thus the ideal realizes itself; faith is directed into the future when, in accordance with its noble requirements, it can worship. In short, God is unknowable for us and not demonstrable by us (the hidden meaning of the epistemological movement); God is demonstrable but as something in process of becoming, and we are part of it, as witness our impulse toward the ideal (the hidden meaning of the historical movement). Observe: criticism is never directed at the ideal itself, but only at the problem, where the opposition to it originates: why it has not yet been achieved or why it is not demonstrable in small things and in great. * It makes all the difference whether one feels this state of distress as a state of distress from passion, from a yearning, or whether one barely reaches it as a problem after the utmost thought and with a certain force of historical imagination. We discover the same phenomenon outside religion and philosophy: utilitarianism (socialism, democracy) criticizes the origin of moral evaluations, but it believes them just as much as the Christian does. (Naïveté: as if morality could survive when the God who sanctions it is missing! The “beyond” absolutely necessary if faith in

morality is to be maintained.) Basic problem: whence this omnipotence of faith? Of faith in morality? (—Which betrays itself in this, too, that even the basic conditions of life are falsely interpreted for the benefit of morality: despite our knowledge of the animal world and the world of plants. “Self-preservation”: the reconciliation of altruistic and egoistic principles in the perspective of Darwinism.) 254 (1885-1886) The inquiry into the origin of our evaluations and tables of the good is in absolutely no way identical with a critique of them, as is so often believed: even though the insight into some *pudenda origo* certainly brings with it a feeling of a diminution in value of the thing that originated thus and prepares the way to a critical mood and attitude toward it. What are our evaluations and moral tables really worth? What is the outcome of their rule? For whom? in relation to what?— Answer: for life. But what is life? Here we need a new, more definite formulation of the concept “life.” My formula for it is: Life is will to power. What is the meaning of the act of evaluation itself? Does it point back or down to another, metaphysical world? (As Kant still believed, who belongs before the great historical movement.) In short: where did it originate? Or did it not “originate”?— Answer: moral evaluation is an exegesis, a way of interpreting. The exegesis itself is a symptom of certain physiological conditions, likewise of a particular spiritual level of prevalent judgments: Who interprets?— Our affects. 255 (1883-1888) All virtues physiological conditions: particularly the principal organic functions considered as necessary, as good. All virtues are really refined passions and enhanced states. Pity and love of mankind as development of the sexual drive. Justice as development of the drive to revenge. Virtue as pleasure in resistance, will to power. Honor as recognition of the similar and equal-in-power. 256 (1887-1888) I understand by “morality” a system of evaluations that partially coincides with the conditions of a creature’s life.

257 (March-June 1888)

Formerly one said of every morality: "By their fruits ye shall know them." I say of every morality: "It is a fruit by which I recognize the soil from which it sprang." 258 (1885-1886) My attempt to understand moral judgments as symptoms and sign languages which betray the processes of physiological prosperity or failure, likewise the consciousness of the conditions for preservation and growth—a mode of interpretations of the same worth as astrology, prejudices prompted by the instincts (of races, communities, of the various stages of life, as youth or decay, etc.). Applied to the specific Christian-European morality: Our moral judgments are signs of decline, of disbelief in life, a preparation for pessimism. My chief proposition: there are no moral phenomena, there is only a moral interpretation of these phenomena. This interpretation itself is of extra-moral origin.⁵² What does it mean that our interpretation has projected a contradiction into existence?— Of decisive importance: behind all other other evaluations these moral evaluations stand in command. Supposing they were abolished, according to what would we measure then? And then of what value would be knowledge, etc., etc. ? ? ? 259 (1884) Insight: all evaluation is made from a definite perspective: that of the preservation of the individual, a community, a race, a state, a church, a faith, a culture.— Because we forget that valuation is always from a perspective, a single individual contains within him a vast confusion of contradictory valuations and consequently of contradictory drives. This is the expression of the diseased condition in man, in contrast to the animals in which all existing instincts answer to quite definite tasks. This contradictory creature has in his nature, however, a great method of acquiring knowledge: he feels many pros and cons, he raises himself to justice—to comprehension beyond esteeming things good and evil. The wisest man would be the one richest in contradictions, who has, as it were, antennae for all types of men—as well as his great moments of grand harmony—a rare accident even in us! A sort of planetary motion— 260 (1883-1888) "Willing": means willing an end. "An end" includes an evaluation. Whence come evaluations? Is their basis a firm norm, "pleasant" and "painful"? But in countless cases we first make a thing painful by investing it with an evaluation The extent of moral evaluations: they play a part in almost every sense impression. Our world is colored by them. We have invested things with ends and values: therefore we have in us an enormous fund of latent force: but by comparing values it appears that contradictory things have been accounted valuable, that many tables of value have existed (thus nothing is valuable "in itself"). Analysis of individual tables of value revealed that their erection was the erection of the conditions—often erroneous—of existence of a limited group—for its preservation. Observation of contemporary man reveals that we employ

very diverse value judgments and that they no longer have any creative force—the basis, “the condition of existence,” is now missing from moral judgment. It is much more superfluous, it is not nearly so painful.— It becomes arbitrary. Chaos. Who creates the goal that stands above mankind and above the individual? Formerly one employed morality for preservation: but nobody wants to preserve any longer, there is nothing to preserve. Therefore an experimental morality: to give oneself a goal. 261 (1883-1888) What is the criterion of a moral action? (1) its disinterestedness, (2) its universal validity, etc. But this is armchair moralizing. One must study peoples to see what the criterion is in every case, and what is expressed by it: a belief that “such a scheme of behavior is one of the first conditions of our existence.” Immoral means “bringing destruction.” Now, all the communities in which these propositions are discovered have perished: certain of these propositions have been reaffirmed again and again because every new community that arose had need of them again; e.g., “Thou shalt not steal.” In ages when it was impossible to demand any feeling for the community (e.g. in the *imperium Romanum*), the drive was directed to “salvation of soul,” in religious language: or “the greatest happiness,” in philosophical terms. For even the Greek moral philosophers no longer had any feeling for their polis.⁵³ 262 (1888) The necessity of false values.— One can refute a judgment by proving its conditionality: the need to retain it is not thereby removed. False values cannot be eradicated by reasons any more than astigmatism in the eyes of an invalid. One must grasp the need for their existence: they are a consequence of causes which have nothing to do with reasons. 263 (1885) To see and to demonstrate the problem of morality—that seems to me the new principal task. I deny that it has been done in previous moral philosophy.

264 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

How false, how mendacious mankind has always been about the basic facts of its inner world! To close one's eyes to this, to speak and not to speak about that—
265 (1885-1888) There is lacking a knowledge and consciousness of the revolutions that have already occurred in moral judgments, and of how fundamentally "evil" has several times been renamed "good." I indicated one of these displacements with the term "morality of custom."⁵⁴ Even conscience has changed its sphere: there used to be a pang of conscience of the herd. 266
(1883-1886) A. Morality as the work of immorality. For moral values to gain dominion they must be assisted by lots of immoral forces and affects. The origin of moral values is the work of immoral affects and considerations. B. Morality as the work of error. C. Morality always contradicts itself. Requital — Veracity, doubt, epoche,⁵⁵ judging.— The "immorality" of belief in morality. The steps: absolute dominion of morality: all biological phenomena measured and judged by moral values. attempt to identify life with morality (symptom of an awakened skepticism: morality must no longer be felt as an antithesis); several means, even a transcendental way. opposition of life and morality: morality judged and condemned from the point of view of life. D. To what extent morality has been detrimental to life: a) to the enjoyment of life, to gratitude towards life, etc., b) to the beautifying, ennobling of life, c) to knowledge of life, d) to the development of life, in so far as it sought to set the highest phenomena of life at variance with itself. E. Counter-reckoning: its usefulness for life. Morality as the principle that preserves the general whole, as a limitation upon its members: "the instrument." Morality as the principle that preserves man from the inner peril of his passions: "the mediocre." Morality as the principle that preserves man from the life-destroying effects of profound misery and atrophy: "the suffering." Morality as the principle that opposes the fearful outbursts of the powerful: "the lowly" 267
(1885-1886) It is a good thing to take "right," "wrong," etc., in a definite, narrow, bourgeois sense, as in "Do right and fear no man": i.e., to do one's duty according to a definite rude scheme within which a community exists. —Let us not think meanly of that which two thousand years of morality have bred in our spirit!

268 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Two types of morality must not be confused: the morality with which the healthy instinct defends itself against incipient decadence—and another morality with which this very decadence defines and justifies itself and leads downwards. The former is usually stoical, hard, tyrannical (—Stoicism itself was such a brake-shoe morality); the latter is enthusiastic, sentimental, full of secrets; it has the women and “beautiful feelings” on its side (—primitive Christianity was such a morality). 269 (1883-1888) To get the whole of moralizing into focus as a phenomenon. Also as a riddle. The phenomena of morality have occupied me like riddles. Today I would know how to answer the question: What does it mean that the welfare of my neighbor ought to possess for me a higher value than my own? but that my neighbor himself ought to assess the value of his welfare differently than I, that is, that he should subordinate it to my welfare? What is the meaning of that “Thou shalt,” which even philosophers regard as “given”? The apparently crazy idea that a man should esteem the actions he performs for another more highly than those he performs for himself, and that this other should likewise, etc. (that one should call good only those actions that a man performs with an eye, not to himself, but to the welfare of another) has a meaning: namely, as the social instinct resting on the valuation that the single individual is of little account, but all individuals together are of very great account provided they constitute a community with a common feeling and a common conscience. Therefore a kind of training in looking in a certain definite direction, the will to a perspective that seeks to make it impossible to see oneself. My idea: goals are lacking and these must be individuals’! We observe how things are everywhere: every individual is sacrificed and serves as a tool. Go into the street and you encounter lots of “ ‘slaves.’ Whither? For what?

270 (Spring-Fall 1887)

How is it possible that a man has respect for himself with regard to moral values alone, that he considers everything else subordinate and of little worth compared with good, evil, improvement, salvation of soul, etc.? e.g., Henri Fréd. Amiel.⁵⁶ What is the meaning of the moral idiosyncrasy?— I mean in a psychological sense, also in a physiological sense; e.g, Pascal. That is, in cases where other great qualities were not lacking; also in the case of Schopenhauer, who obviously valued that which he did not and could not have—is it not the consequence of a merely habitual moral interpretation of actual states of pain and displeasure? is it not a definite kind of sensibility that does not understand the cause of its frequent feelings of displeasure but believes it explains them with moral hypotheses? So that even a transitory feeling of health and strength immediately appears, in the perspective of a “good conscience,” to be illumined by the nearness of God, by the consciousness of redemption?— Thus the man of moral idiosyncrasy has (1) either really acquired his worth through approximating society’s model of virtue: “the good man,” “the righteous”—a highly respectable condition of mediocrity: mediocre in all his abilities but decent, conscientious, solid, respected, trusty; (2) or he believes he has acquired it because he does not know how otherwise to understand all his states—he is unknown to himself, so he interpretes himself in this way.— Morality as the only scheme of interpretation by which man can endure himself—a kind of pride?—

271 (March-June 1888)

The predominance of moral values.— Consequences of this predominance: the corruption of psychology, etc.; the universal fatality which follows from it. What does this predominance mean? What does it point to?— To a certain greater urgency for a definite Yes and No in this field. All kinds of imperatives have been employed to make moral values appear permanent: they have been commanded for the longest time:— they seem instinctive, like inner commands. Moral values reveal themselves to be conditions of the existence of society, in that they are felt to be beyond discussion. The practice, which is to say the utility, of agreement about the highest values has here acquired a kind of sanction. We observe that every means is employed to paralyze reflection and criticism in this field:— look at the attitude of Kant! not to speak of those who reject as immoral all “inquiry” here—

272 (Spring-Fall 1887)

My purpose: to demonstrate the absolute homogeneity of all events and the application of moral distinctions as conditioned by perspective; to demonstrate how everything praised as moral is identical in essence with everything immoral and was made possible, as in every development of morality, with immoral means and for immoral ends—; how, on the other hand, everything decried as immoral is, economically considered, higher and more essential, and how a development toward a greater fullness of life necessarily also demands the advance of immorality. “Truth” the extent to which we permit ourselves to understand this fact. 273 (1883-1888) But don’t worry: for one needs a great deal of morality to be immoral in this subtle way; I will speak in a parable: A physiologist interested in a disease and an invalid who claims to be cured of it do not have identical interests. Let us suppose the disease is morality—for it is a disease—and that we Europeans are the invalids: what subtle torment and difficulties would arise if we Europeans were at the same time inquisitive spectators and physiologists! Would we then really desire to be free of morality? Would we want to be? Quite apart from the question whether we could be. Whether we could be “cured.”—

274 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Whose will to power is morality?— The common factor in the history of Europe since Socrates is the attempt to make moral values dominate over all other values: so that they should be the guide and judge not only of life but also of (1) knowledge, (2) the arts, (3) political and social endeavors. “Improvement” the sole duty, everything else a means to it (or a disturbance, hindrance, danger: consequently to be combatted to the point of annihilation—). A similar movement in China. A similar movement in India. What is the meaning of this will to power on the part of moral values which has developed so tremendously on earth? Answer.— three powers are hidden behind it: (1) the instinct of the herd against the strong and independent; (2) the instinct of the suffering and underprivileged against the fortunate; (3) the instinct of the mediocre against the exceptional.— Enormous advantage possessed by this movement, however much cruelty, falseness, and narrow-mindedness have assisted it (for the history of the struggle of morality with the basic instincts of life is itself the greatest piece of immorality that has yet existed on earth—). 275 (1883-1888) Very few manage to see a problem in that which makes our daily life, that to which we have long since grown accustomed— our eyes are not adjusted to it: this seems to me to be the case especially in regard to our morality. The problem “every man as an object for others” is the occasion of the highest honors: for himself—no! The problem “thou shalt”: an inclination that cannot explain itself, similar to the sexual drive, shall not fall under the general condemnation of the drives; on the contrary, it shall be their evaluation and judge! The problem of “equality,” while we all thirst after distinction: here, on the contrary, we are supposed to make exactly the same demands on ourselves as we make on others. This is so insipid, so obviously crazy: but—it is felt to be holy, of a higher rank, the conflict with reason is hardly noticed. Sacrifice and selflessness as distinguishing, unconditional obedience to morality, and the faith that one is everyone’s equal before it. The neglect and surrender of well-being and life as distinguishing, the complete renunciation of making one’s own evaluations, and the firm desire to see everyone else renounce them too. “The value of an action is determined: everyone is subject to this valuation.” We see: an authority speaks—who speaks? — One may forgive human pride if it sought to make this authority as high as possible in order to feel as little humiliated as possible under it. Therefore—God speaks! One needed God as an unconditional sanction, with no court of appeal, as a “categorical imperator”—: or, if one believed in the authority of reason, one needed a metaphysics of unity, by virtue of which this was logical. Now suppose that belief in God has vanished: the question presents itself anew: “who speaks?”— My answer, taken not from metaphysics but from animal physiology: the herd instinct speaks. It wants to be master: hence its “thou shalt!”— it will

allow value to the individual only from the point of view of the whole, for the sake of the whole, it hates those who detach themselves—it turns the hatred of all individuals against them. 276 (1886-1887) The whole of European morality is based upon what is useful to the herd: the affliction of all higher, rarer men lies in this, that everything that distinguishes them enters their consciousness accompanied by a feeling of diminution and discredit. The strong points of contemporary men are the causes of their pessimistic gloom: the mediocre are, like the herd, little troubled with questions and conscience—cheerful. (On the gloominess of the strong: Pascal, Schopenhauer.) The more dangerous a quality seems to the herd, the more thoroughly is it proscribed. 277 (1883-1888) Morality of truthfulness in the herd. “You shall be knowable, express your inner nature by clear and constant signs—otherwise you are dangerous: and if you are evil, your ability to dissimulate is the worst thing for the herd. We despise the secret and unrecognizable.— Consequently you must consider yourself knowable, you may not be concealed from yourself, you may not believe that you change.” Thus: the demand for truthfulness presupposes the knowability and stability of the person. In fact, it is the object of education to create in the herd member a definite faith concerning the nature of man: it first invents this faith and then demands “truthfulness.” 278 (1885) Within a herd, within any community, that is to say *inter pares*,⁵⁷ the overestimation of truthfulness makes good sense. Not to be deceived—and consequently, as a personal point of morality, not to deceive! a mutual obligation between equals! In dealing with what lies outside, danger and caution demand that one should be on one’s guard against deception: as a psychological preconditioning for this, also in dealing with what lies within. Mistrust as the source of truthfulness. 279 (1883-1888) Toward a critique of the herd virtues.— Inertia operates (1) in trustfulness, since mistrust makes tension, observation, reflection necessary;— (2) in veneration, where the difference in power is great and submission necessary: so as not to fear, an attempt is made to love, esteem, and to interpret the disparity in power as disparity in value: so that the relationship no longer makes one rebellious;— (3) in the sense of truth. What is true? Where an explanation is given which causes us the minimum of spiritual effort (moreover, lying is very exhausting);— (4) in sympathy. It is a relief to count oneself the same as others, to try to feel as they do, to adopt a current feeling: it is something passive compared with the activity that maintains and constantly practices the individual’s right to value judgments (the latter allows of no rest);— (5) in impartiality and coolness of judgment: one shuns the exertion of affects and prefers to stay detached, “objective”;— (6) in integrity: one would rather obey an existing law than create a law oneself, than command oneself and others: the fear of commanding—: better to submit than to react;— (7) in toleration: the fear of exercising rights, of judging.

280 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The instinct of the herd considers the middle and the mean as the highest and most valuable: the place where the majority finds itself; the mode and manner in which it finds itself. It is therefore an opponent of all orders of rank, it sees an ascent from beneath to above as a descent from the majority to the minority. The herd feels the exception, whether it be below or above it, as something opposed and harmful to it. Its artifice with reference to the exceptions above it, the stronger, more powerful, wiser, and more fruitful, is to persuade them to assume the role of guardians, herdsmen, watchmen—to become its first servants:⁵⁸ it has therewith transformed a danger into something useful. Fear ceases in the middle: here one is never alone; here there is little room for misunderstanding; here there is equality; here one's own form of being is not felt as a reproach but as the right form of being; here contentment rules. Mistrust is felt toward the exceptions; to be an exception is experienced as guilt.

281 (March-June 1888)

When, following the instinct of the community, we make prescriptions and forbid ourselves certain actions, we quite reasonably do not forbid a mode of “being,” a “disposition,” but only a certain direction and application of this “being,” this “disposition.” But then the ideologist of virtue, the moralist, comes along and says: “God sees into the heart! What does it matter if you refrain from certain actions: you are no better for that!” Answer: My dear Sir Long-Ears-and-Virtuous, we have no desire whatever to be better, we are very contented with ourselves, all we desire is not to harm one another—and therefore we forbid certain actions when they are directed in a certain way, namely against us, while we cannot sufficiently honor these same actions provided they are directed against enemies of the community—against you, for instance. We educate our children in them; we cultivate them— If we shared that “God-pleasing” radicalism that your holy madness recommends, if we were fools enough to condemn together with those actions the source of them, the “heart,” the “disposition,” that would mean condemning our own existence and with it its supreme prerequisite—a disposition, a heart, a passion we honor with the highest honors. By our decrees, we prevent this disposition from breaking out and expressing itself in an inexpedient way—we are prudent when we make such law for ourselves, we are also moral— Have you no suspicion, however faint, what sacrifice it is costing us, how much taming, self-overcoming, severity toward ourselves it requires? We are vehement in our desires, there are times when we would like to devour each other— But the “sense of community” masters us: please note that this is almost a definition of morality.

282 (Fall 1888)

The weakness of the herd animal produces a morality very similar to that produced by the weakness of the decadent: they understand one another, they form an alliance (—the great decadence religions always count on the support of the herd). In itself, there is nothing sick about the herd animal, it is even invaluable; but, incapable of leading itself, it needs a “shepherd”— the priests understand that— The state is not intimate, not clandestine enough; “directing the conscience” eludes it. And that is how the herd animal has been made sick by the priest?— 283 (1883-1888) Hatred for the privileged in body and soul: revolt of the ugly, ill-constituted souls against the beautiful, proud, joyous. Their means: inculcation of beauty, pride, joy: “there is no merit,” “the danger is tremendous: one should tremble and feel ill,” “naturalness is evil; it is right to oppose nature.” Also “reason.” (The antinatural as the higher). Again it is the priests who exploit this condition and win the “people” over. “The sinner” in whom God has more joy than in the “just man” This is the struggle against “paganism” (the pang of conscience as the means of destroying harmony of soul). The hatred of the average for the exceptional, of the herd for the independent. (Custom as true “morality”⁵⁹) Turning against “egoism”: only the “for another” has value. “We are all equal”;— against lust for dominion, against “dominion” in general;— against privilege;— against sectarians, free spirits, skeptics;— against philosophy (as opposing the tool-and-corner instinct); with philosophers themselves “the categorical imperative,” the essence of morality “universal and general.”

284 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The conditions and desires that are praised:— peaceable, fair, moderate, modest, reverent, considerate, brave, chaste, honest, faithful, devout, straight, trusting, devoted, sympathetic, helpful, conscientious, simple, mild, just, generous, indulgent, obedient, disinterested, unenvious, gracious, industrious— To distinguish: to what extent such qualities are conditioned as means to a definite aim and end (often an “evil” end); or as natural consequences of a dominating affect (e.g. spirituality) or expression of a state of distress, which is to say: as condition of existence (e.g., citizen, slave, woman, etc.). Summa: they are none of them felt to be “good” for their own sake, but from the first according to the standards of “society,” “the herd,” as means to the ends of society and the herd, as necessary to their preservation and advancement, at the same time as the consequence of an actual herd instinct in the individual: thus in the service of an instinct which is fundamentally different from these conditions of virtue. For the herd is, in relation to the outside world, hostile, selfish, unmerciful, full of lust for dominion, mistrust, etc. In the “shepherd” this antagonism becomes patent: he must possess opposite qualities to the herd. Mortal enmity of the herd toward orders of rank: its instinct favors the leveller (Christ) Toward strong individuals (les souverains) it is hostile, unfair, immoderate, immodest, impudent, inconsiderate, cowardly, mendacious, false, unmerciful, underhand, envious, revengeful. 285 (1884) I teach: the herd seeks to preserve one type and defends itself on both sides, against those who have degenerated from it (criminals, etc.) and those who tower above it. The tendency of the herd is directed toward standstill and preservation, there is nothing creative in it. The pleasant feelings with which the good, benevolent, just man inspires us (in contrast to the tension, fear which the great, new man arouses) are our own feelings of personal security and equality: the herd animal thus glorifies the herd nature and then it feels comfortable. This judgment of comfort masks itself with fair words—thus “morality” arises.— But observe the hatred of the herd for the truthful.— 286 (1883-1888) Let one not be deceived about oneself! If one hears within oneself the moral imperative as it is understood by altruism, one belongs to the herd. If one has the opposite feeling, if one feels one’s danger and aberration lies in disinterested and selfless actions, one does not belong to the herd. 287 (1883-1888) My philosophy aims at an ordering of rank: not at an individualistic morality.⁶⁰ The ideas of the herd should rule in the herd—but not reach out beyond it: the leaders of the herd require a fundamentally different valuation for their own actions, as do the independent, or the “beasts of prey,” etc.

288 (March-June 1888)

Morality as an attempt to establish human pride.— The theory of “free will” is antireligious. It seeks to create the right for man to think of himself as cause of his exalted state and actions: it is a form of the growing feeling of pride. Man feels his power, his “happiness,” as they say: there must be “will” behind this state—otherwise it would not be his. Virtue is the attempt to set the fact of willing and having-willed before every exalted and strong feeling of happiness as a necessary antecedent:— if the will to certain actions is regularly present in the consciousness, a feeling of power may be interpreted as its effect.— This is merely a perspective of psychology: always based on the false presupposition that nothing belongs to us that we have not consciously willed. The entire theory of responsibility depends upon the naive psychology that the only cause is will and that one must be aware of having willed in order to believe in oneself as cause. —Comes the countermovement: that of the moral philosophers, still subject to the same prejudice that one is responsible only for what one has willed. The value of man is posited as a moral value: consequently his morality must be a *causa prima*;⁶¹ consequently there must be a principle in man, a “free will” as *causa prima*.— The idea behind it is: if man is not *causa prima* as will, then he is irresponsible—consequently he has no business before the moral tribunal—virtue and vice would be automatic and mechanical— In summa: so that man may respect himself he must be capable of doing evil.

289 (March-June 1888)

Play-acting as a consequence of the morality of “free will.”— It is a step in the development of the feeling of power itself to have caused one’s own exalted states (one’s perfection)—consequently, one immediately concludes, to have willed them— (Critique: All perfect acts are unconscious and no longer subject to will; consciousness is the expression of an imperfect and often morbid state in a person. Personal perfection as conditioned by will, as consciousness, as reasoning with dialectics, is a caricature, a kind of self-contradiction— A degree of consciousness makes perfection impossible— Form of play-acting.)

290 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The moral hypothesis with the object of justifying God was: evil must be voluntary (merely so that the voluntariness of goodness can be believed in), and on the other hand: the object of evil and suffering is salvation. The concept “guilt” as not extending back to the ultimate ground of existence, and the concept “punishment” as an educative benefit, consequently as the act of a good God. Absolute dominion of moral valuation over all others: one did not doubt that God could not be evil and could not do anything harmful, i.e., by “perfection” one meant merely a moral perfection.

291 (March-June 1888)

How false is the idea that the value of an action must depend upon that which preceded it in consciousness!— And morality has been judged according to this, even criminality— The value of an action must be judged by its consequences— say the Utilitarians—: to judge it by its origins implies an impossibility, namely that of knowing its origins But does one know its consequences? For five steps ahead, perhaps. Who can say what an action will stimulate, excite, provoke? As a stimulus? Perhaps as a spark to touch off an explosion?— The Utilitarians are naive— And in any case we must first know what is useful: here too they look only five steps ahead— They have no conception of the grand economy, which cannot do without evil. One does not know the origin, one does not know the consequences — does an action then possess any value at all? The action itself remains: its epiphenomena in consciousness, the Yes and the No that follow its performance: does the value of an action lie in its subjective epiphenomena? (— that would be like assessing the value of the music according to the pleasure or displeasure it gives us—it gives its composer—). Obviously value feelings accompany it, a feeling of power, compulsion, impotence; e g, freedom, ease— put in another way: could one reduce the value of an action to physiological values: whether it is the expression of a complete or an inhibited life?⁶²— It may be that its biological value is expressed in this— If therefore an action can be evaluated neither by its origin, nor by its consequences, nor by its epiphenomena, then its value is “x” unknown—

292 (Spring-Fall 1887)

On the denaturalization of morality. To separate the action from the man; to direct hatred or contempt against the “sin”; to believe there are actions that are good or bad in themselves.⁶³ Restoration of “nature”: an action in itself is perfectly devoid of value: it all depends on who performs it. One and the same “crime” can be in one case the greatest privilege, in another a stigma. In fact, it is the selfishness of the judges which interprets an action, or its performer, in relation to its utility or harmfulness to themselves (—or in relation to its similarity or unlikeness to them).

293 (March-June 1888)

The concept “reprehensible action” presents us with difficulties. Nothing that happened at all can be reprehensible in itself: for one should not want to eliminate it: for everything is so bound up with everything else, that to want to exclude something means to exclude everything. A reprehensible action means: a reprehended world— And then further: in a reprehended world reprehending would also be reprehensible— And the consequence of a way of thinking that reprehended everything would be a way of living that affirmed everything— If becoming is a great ring, then everything is equally valuable, eternal, necessary. — In all correlations of Yes and No, of preference and rejection, love and hate, all that is expressed is a perspective, an interest of certain types of life: in itself, everything that is says Yes.

294 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Critique of subjective value feelings.— The conscience. Formerly one concluded: the conscience reprehends this action; consequently this action is reprehensible. In fact, the conscience reprehends an action because it has been reprehended for a long time. It merely repeats: it creates no values. That which in the past decided to reprehend certain actions was not conscience: but the insight into (or the prejudice against) their consequences— The assent of the conscience, the pleasant feeling of “at peace with oneself,” is of the same order as the pleasure of an artist in his work—it proves nothing at all— Self-contentment is as little a standard for that to which it relates as its absence is an argument against the value of a thing. We do not know nearly enough to be able to measure the value of our actions: in addition, it is impossible for us to be objective about them: even when we reprehend an action, we are not judges but interested parties — If noble agitation accompanies an action, this proves nothing about its value: an artist can go through the highest possible pathos of passion and bring forth something wretched. One should say rather that these agitations are a means of seduction: they lure our eyes, our strength away from criticism, from caution, from suspicion, so that we perpetrate a stupidity—they make us stupid— 295 (1885-1886) We are the heirs of the conscience-vivisection and self-crucifixion of two millennia: in these we have had longest practice, in these lies our mastery perhaps, certainly our subtlety; we have conjoined the natural inclinations and a bad conscience. A reverse attempt would be possible: to conjoin the unnatural inclinations, I mean the inclination for the beyond, for things contrary to sense, reason, nature, in short all previous ideals, which were all world-slandering ideals, with a bad conscience.

296 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The great crimes in psychology: that all displeasure, all misfortune has been falsified with the idea of wrong (guilt). (Pain has been robbed of innocence); that all strong feelings of pleasure (wild spirits, voluptuousness, triumph, pride, audacity, knowledge, self-assurance and happiness as such) have been branded as sinful, as a seduction, as suspicious; that feelings of weakness, inward acts of cowardice, lack of courage for oneself have been overlaid with sanctifying names and taught as being desirable in the highest degree; that everything great in man has been reinterpreted as selflessness, as self-sacrifice for the sake of something else, someone else, that even in the man of knowledge, even in the artist, depersonalization has been presented as the cause of the greatest knowledge and ability; that love has been falsified as surrender (and altruism), while it is an appropriation or a bestowal following from a superabundance of personality. Only the most complete persons can love; the depersonalized, the “objective,” are the worst lovers (—one has only to ask the girls!) This applies also to love of God or of “fatherland”; one must be firmly rooted in oneself. (Egoism as ego-morphism, altruism as alter-ation.⁶⁴ Life as punishment (happiness as temptation); the passions as devilish, confidence in oneself as godless. This whole psychology is a psychology of prevention, a kind of immuring out of fear; on one hand the great masses (the underprivileged and mediocre) seek to defend themselves by means of it against the stronger (—and to destroy them in their development—), on the other all the drives through which they best prosper, sanctified and alone held in honor. Compare the Jewish priesthood.

297 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The vestiges of debasement of nature through moral transcendence: value of selflessness, cult of altruism; belief in repayment within the play of consequences; belief in “goodness,” in “genius” even, as if the one and the other were consequences of selflessness; the continuance of the ecclesiastical sanction of bourgeois life; absolute desire to misunderstand history (as an educative work toward moralization) or pessimism in the face of history (—the latter as much a consequence of the debasement of nature as that pseudo justification, as that not desiring to see that which the pessimist sees—).

298 (Spring-Fall 1887)

“Morality for morality’s sake”—an important step in its denaturalization: it itself appears as the ultimate value. In this phase it has permeated religion: e.g., in Judaism. And there is likewise a phase in which it separates itself again from religion and in which no God is “moral” enough for it: it then prefers the impersonal ideal— This is the case at present. “Art for art’s sake”—this is an equally dangerous principle: therewith one introduces a false antithesis into things—it culminates in a defamation of reality (“idealization” into the ugly). If one severs an ideal from reality one debases the real, one impoverishes it, one defames it. “The beautiful for the sake of the beautiful,” “the true for the sake of the true,” “the good for the sake of the good”—these are three forms of evil eye for the real. —Art, knowledge, morality are means: instead of recognizing in them the aim of enhancing life, one has associated them with the antithesis of life, with “God”—also as the revelation of a higher world which here and there looks down upon us through them— “Beautiful and ugly,” “true and false,” “good and evil”— these distinctions and antagonisms betray certain conditions of existence and enhancement, not only of man but of any kind of firm and enduring complex which separates itself from its adversary. The war that is thus created is the essential element: as a means of separation that strengthens isolation—

299 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Moralistic naturalism: the tracing back of apparently emancipated, supranatural moral values to their “nature”: i.e., to natural immorality, to natural “utility,” etc. I might designate the tendency of these reflections as moralistic naturalism: my task is to translate the apparently emancipated and denatured moral values back into their nature—ie., into their natural “immorality.” —N.B. Comparison with Jewish “holiness” and its natural basis: it is the same with the moral law made sovereign, emancipated from its nature (—to the point of becoming the antithesis of nature—). Steps in the denaturalization of morality (so-called “idealization”): as a way to individual happiness, as a consequence of knowledge, as the categorical imperative, as a way to salvation, as denial of the will to live. (The gradual hostility to life of morality.)

300 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Suppressed and effaced heresy in morality.— Concepts: pagan, master morality, virtù. 301 (1885-1886) My problem: What harm has come to mankind through morals and through its morality? Harm to the spirit, etc.

302 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

If only human values would be put back once and for all into the places in which alone they belong; as loafers' values. Many species of animals have already vanished; if man too should vanish nothing would be lacking in the world One must be sufficient of a philosopher to admire this nothing, too (—Nil admirari).
65

303 (Spring 1888)

Man a little, eccentric species of animal, which—fortunately—has its day; all on earth a mere moment, an incident, an exception without consequences, something of no importance to the general character of the earth; the earth itself, like every star, a hiatus between two nothingnesses, an event without plan, reason, will, self-consciousness, the worst kind of necessity, stupid necessity— Something in us rebels against this view; the serpent vanity says to us: “all that must be false, for it arouses indignation— Could all that not be merely appearance? And man, in spite of all, as Kant says—”

304 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Of the ideal of the moralists.⁶⁶— This treatise deals with the grand politics of virtue. It is intended for the use of those whose interest must lie in learning, not how one becomes virtuous, but how one makes virtuous—how virtue is made to dominate. I even intend to prove that to desire the one—the domination of virtue—one absolutely must not desire the other; one automatically renounces becoming virtuous oneself. This is a great sacrifice; but such a goal is perhaps sufficient reward for such a sacrifice. And for even greater sacrifices!— And some of the most famous moralists have risked as much. For they had already recognized and anticipated the truth, which is in this treatise to be taught for the first time, that one can achieve the domination of virtue only by the same means as those by which one can achieve domination of any kind, in any case not by means of virtue— This treatise, as already stated, deals with the politics of virtue: it posits an ideal of these politics, it describes them as they would have to be, if anything on this earth could be perfect. Now, no philosopher will be in any doubt as to the type of perfection in politics; that is Machiavellianism. But Machiavellianism pur, sans mélange, cru, vert, dans toute sa force, dans toute son âpreté,⁶⁷ is superhuman, divine, transcendental, it will never be achieved by man, at most approximated. Even in this narrower kind of politics, in the politics of virtue, the ideal seems never to have been achieved. Even Plato barely touched it. One discovers, if one has eyes for hidden things, traces in even the most unprejudiced and conscious moralists (and that is indeed the name for such politicians of morality, for every kind of founder of new moral forces) that show that they too have paid their tribute to human weakness. They all aspired, at least when they were weary, to virtue for themselves: first and capital error for a moralist—who must as such be an immoralist in practice. That he must not appear to be so is another matter. Or rather, it is not another matter. such a fundamental self-denial (in moral terms, dissimulation) is part of the canon of the moralist and his most specific duties: without it he will never attain to his kind of perfection. Freedom from morality, also from truth, for the sake of that goal that outweighs every sacrifice: for the sake of the domination of virtue—that is the canon. Moralists need the gestures of virtue, also the gestures of truth; their error begins only when they yield to virtue, when they lose domination over virtue, when they themselves become moral, become true. A great moralist is, among other things, necessarily a great actor; his danger is that his dissimulation may unintentionally become nature, while it is his ideal to keep his *esse* and his *operari* in a divine way apart; everything he does must be done *sub specie boni*— a high, remote, exacting ideal! A divine ideal! And indeed, it is said that the

moralist imitates in that no less a model than God himself: God, the greatest of all immoralists in practice, who nonetheless knows how to remain what he is, the good God—

305 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

One cannot establish the domination of virtue by means of virtue itself; with virtue itself one renounces power, loses the will to power. 306 (1883-1886)⁷⁰
The victory of a moral ideal is achieved by the same “immoral” means as every victory: force, lies, slander, injustice.

307 (Spring-Fall 1887)

He who knows how all fame originates will be mistrustful even of the fame virtue enjoys.

308 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Morality is just as “immoral” as any other thing on earth; morality is itself a form of immorality. The great liberation this insight brings. Contradiction is removed from things, the homogeneity of all events is saved—

309 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

There are those who go looking for immorality. When they judge: "This is wrong," they believe one should abolish and change it. I, on the contrary, cannot rest as long as I am not yet clear about the immorality of a thing. When I unearth it I recover my equanimity.

310 (Spring-Fall 1887)

a. The paths to power: to introduce a new virtue under the name of an old one—to excite “interest” in it (“happiness” as its consequence and vice versa)—the art of slandering what stands in its way—to exploit advantages and accidents for its glorification—to turn its followers into fanatics by means of sacrifice and separation;—grand symbolism. b. Power attained: (1) virtue as force; (2) virtue as seduction; (3) virtue as (court) etiquette.

311 (Spring-Fall 1887)

By which means does a virtue come to power?— By exactly the same means as a political party: the slandering, inculcation, undermining of virtues that oppose it and are already in power, by rebaptizing them, by systematic persecution and mockery. Therefore: through sheer “immorality.” What does a desire do with itself to become a virtue?— Rebaptism; systematic denial of its objectives; practice in self-misunderstanding; alliance with existing and recognized virtues; ostentatious hostility against their opponents. Where possible it purchases the protection of sanctifying powers; it intoxicates, it inspires; the tartuffery of idealism; it forms a party which must either conquer with it or perish—it becomes unconscious, naive—

312 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

Cruelty has been refined to tragic pity, so that it is denied the name of cruelty. In the same way sexual love has been refined to amour-passion; the slavish disposition to Christian obedience; wretchedness to humility; a pathological condition of the nervus sympathicus, e.g., to pessimism, Pascalism, or Carlylism, etc.

313 (March-June 1888)

It would arouse doubts in us concerning a man if we heard he needed reasons for remaining decent: certainly, we would avoid him. The little word “for” can be compromising in certain cases; one can even refute oneself now and then with a single “for.”⁷¹ Now, if we hear further that such an aspirant to virtue needed bad reasons for remaining respectable, this would be no reason for us to feel an increased respect for him. But he goes further, he comes to us and tells us to our face: “Unbeliever, you are disturbing my morality with your unbelief; as long as you do not believe in my bad reasons, which is to say in God, in a punishment in the beyond, in freedom of will, you hamper my virtue— Moral: unbelievers must be abolished: they hamper the moralization of the masses.”

314 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Our most sacred convictions, the unchanging elements in our supreme values, are judgments of our muscles.

315 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Morality in the valuation of races and classes.— In view of the fact that the affects and fundamental drives in every race and class express something of the conditions of their existence (—at least of the conditions under which they have prevailed for the longest time), to desire that they should be “virtuous” means: that they change their character, shed their skin and blot out their past: means that they should cease to be distinct: means that they should begin to resemble one another in their needs and demands—more clearly that they should perish— The will to a single morality is thereby proved to be a tyranny over other types by that type whom this single morality fits: it is a destruction or a leveling for the sake of the ruling type (whether to render the others no longer fearsome or to render them useful). “Abolition of slavery”—supposedly a tribute to “human dignity,” in fact a destruction of a fundamentally different type (—the undermining of its values and happiness—). The qualities in which an opposing race or class is strong are interpreted as its most evil, worst qualities: for it is with those that it can harm us (—its “virtues” are defamed and rebaptized—). It counts as an objection against a man or people if they harm us: but from their point of view we are desirable, because we are such as one can make use of. The demand for “humanization” (which quite naively believes itself to possess the formula for “what is human?”) is a tartuffery, behind which a quite definite type of man seeks to attain domination: more exactly, a quite definite instinct, the herd instinct — “Human equality”: which is concealed behind the tendency to make men more and more alike. “Interestedness” with reference to communal morality. (Artifice: to transform the great passions of lust for power and possessions into protectors of virtue). To what extent all kinds of businessmen and the avaricious, all who have to give and claim credit, find it necessary to become more and more alike in character and in conception of value: world trade and exchange of every kind extorts and, as it were, buys virtue. The same applies to the state and to every kind of rule by means of officials and soldiers; likewise science, in order to work in security and with economy of its forces.— Likewise the priesthood. — Here, therefore, a communal morality is enforced because it procures an advantage; and to make it victorious, war and force are practiced against immorality—with what “right”? With no right whatever: but in accordance with the instinct for self-preservation. These same classes make use of immorality when it serves their purpose.

316 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The hypocritical show with which all civil institutions are whitewashed, as if they were products of morality—e.g., marriage; work; one's profession; the fatherland; the family; order; law. But since they are one and all founded on the most mediocre type of man, as protection against exceptions and exceptional needs, it is only to be expected that they are full of lies.

317 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

One should defend virtue against the preachers of virtue: they are its worst enemies. For they teach virtue as an ideal for everyone; they take from virtue the charm of rareness, inimitableness, exceptionalness and unaverageness—its aristocratic magic. One should also take a stand against the obdurate idealists who eagerly knock on all vessels and are satisfied when they ring hollow: what naïveté to demand the great and rare and then to establish, with rage and misanthropy, that they are absent!— It is obvious, e g, that a marriage is worth as much as those whom it joins together, i.e., that in general it will be something wretched and inept: no priest, no mayor can make anything else of it. Virtue has all the instincts of the average man against it: it is unprofitable, imprudent, it isolates; it is related to passion and not very accessible to reason; it spoils the character, the head, the mind—according to the standards of mediocre men; it rouses to enmity toward order, toward the lies that are concealed in every order, institution, actuality—it is the worst of vices, if one judges it by its harmful effect upon others. —I recognize virtue in that (1) it does not desire to be recognized; (2) it does not presuppose virtue everywhere, but precisely something else; (3) it does not suffer from the absence of virtue, but on the contrary regards this as the distancing relationship on the basis of which there is something to honor in virtue; it does not communicate itself; (4) it does not propagandize— (5) it permits no one to judge it, because it is always virtue for itself; (6) it does precisely all that is generally forbidden: virtue, as I understand it, is the real vetitum within all herd legislation; (7) in short, it is virtue in the style of the Renaissance, virtù, moraline-free virtue.⁷³

318 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Above all, gentlemen of virtue, you are not our superiors: we should like you to be a little more modest: it is a miserable self-interest and prudence that suggests your virtue to you. And if you had more strength and courage in you, you would not reduce yourselves to virtuous nonentities in this way. You make what you can of yourselves: partly what you must—what your circumstances force you to—partly what gives you pleasure, partly what seems useful to you. But if you do only what is in keeping with your inclinations, or what necessity demands of you, or what is useful to you, then you should neither praise yourselves nor let others praise you!— One is a thoroughly small type of man if one is only virtuous: do not be misled about that! Men who have been in any way notable were never such virtuous asses: their innermost instinct, that of their quantum of power, did not find satisfaction that way: while, with your minimum of power, nothing can seem wiser to you than virtue. But you have numbers on your side; and in so far as you play the tyrant, we shall make war on you—

319 (Spring-Fall 1887)

A virtuous man is a lower species because he is not a “person” but acquires his value by conforming to a pattern of man that is fixed once and for all. He does not possess his value apart: he can be compared, he has his equals, he must not be an individual— Reckon up the qualities of the good man: why do they give us pleasure? Because we have no need to fight against them, because they impose upon us no mistrust, no need for caution, no marshalling of forces and severity: our laziness, good nature, frivolity, have a good time. It is this pleasant feeling in us that we project out of us and bestow upon the good man as a quality, as a value. 320 (1888) Virtue is under certain circumstances merely an honorable form of stupidity: who could be ill-disposed toward it on that account? And this kind of virtue has not been outlived even today. A kind of sturdy peasant simplicity, which, however, is possible in all classes and can be encountered only with respect and a smile, believes even today that everything is in good hands, namely in the “hands of God”; and when it maintains this proposition with the same modest certainty as it would that two and two make four, we others certainly refrain from contradicting. Why disturb this pure foolishness? Why darken it with our worries about man, people, goal, future? And even if we wanted to do it, we could not. They project their own honorable stupidity and goodness into the heart of things (the old God, *deus myops*,⁷⁴ still lives among them!); we others—we read something else into the heart of things: our own enigmatic nature, our contradictions, our deeper, more painful, more mistrustful wisdom.

321 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

He who finds virtue easy also laughs at it. It is impossible to maintain seriousness in virtue: one attains it and leaps beyond it—whither? into devilry. In the meantime, how intelligent all our wicked tendencies and impulses have become! how much scientific inquisitiveness plagues them! So many fishhooks of knowledge!

322 (Spring-Fall 1887)

—To associate vice so closely with something decidedly painful that at last one flees from vice in order to be rid of that which is associated with it. This is the famous case of Tannhäuser Driven out of patience by Wagnerian music, Tannhäuser can no longer endure it even with Frau Venus: suddenly virtue acquires a charm; a Thuringian virgin increases in value; and, to tell the worst, he even enjoys Wolfram von Eschenbach's tune—

323 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The patrons of virtue.—Avarice, lust to rule, laziness, simplicity, fear: all have an interest in the cause of virtue: that is why it stands so firm.

324 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Virtue is no longer believed in, its power of attraction is gone; to restore it, someone would have to know how to take it to market as an unfamiliar form of adventure and excess. It demands too much extravagance and narrow-mindedness of its believers not to have the conscience against it today. To be sure, precisely that may constitute its new charm for unconscionable and totally unscrupulous people:— it is now what it never was before, a vice.

325 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Virtue is still the most expensive vice: it should remain so! 326 (1883-1888)

Virtues are as dangerous as vices in so far as one lets them rule over one as authorities and laws from without and does not first produce them out of oneself, as one should do, as one's most personal self-defense and necessity, as conditions of precisely our own existence and growth, which we recognize and acknowledge independently of whether other men grow with us under similar or different conditions. This law of the dangerousness of impersonally understood, objective virtue applies also to modesty: many of the choicest spirits perish through it. The morality of modesty is the worst form of softening for those souls for which it makes sense that they should become hard in time.

327 (Spring-Fall 1887)

One should reduce and limit the realm of morality step by step: one should bring to light and honor the names of the instincts that are really at work here after they have been hidden for so long beneath hypocritical names of virtue; out of respect for one's "honesty," which speaks more and more imperiously, one should unlearn the shame that would like to deny and lie away one's natural instincts. It is a measure of strength how far one can divest oneself of virtue; and a height can be imagined where the concept "virtue" is so understood that it sounds like *virtù*, Renaissance virtue, moraline-free virtue.⁷⁵ But in the meantime—how distant we are from this ideal! The reduction of the domain of morality: a sign of the progress of this ideal. Wherever one has not yet been capable of causal thinking, one has thought morally.

328 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

In the end: what have I achieved? Let us not hide from ourselves this most curious result: I have imparted to virtue a new charm—the charm of something forbidden. It has our subtlest honesty against it, it is spiced “cum grano salis”⁷⁶ of the sting of scientific conscience; it smells old-fashioned and antique, so that at last it lures the refined and makes them inquisitive—in short, it appears as a vice. Only after we have recognized everything as lies and appearance do we regain the right to this fairest of falsehoods, virtue. There is no court of appeal left that could deny it to us: only by exhibiting virtue as a form of immorality do we again justify it—it is classified and compared with reference to its fundamental significance, it is part of the fundamental immorality of all existence—as a form of luxury of the first order, the haughtiest, dearest and rarest form of vice. We have removed its scowl and its cowl, we have rescued it from the importunity of the many, we have taken from it its absurd rigidity, its vacant expression, its stiff false hair, its hieratic muscular system.

329 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. 1888)

Have I thereby harmed virtue?— As little as the anarchists harm princes: only since they have been shot at do they sit securely on their thrones again— For thus has it ever been and always will be: one cannot serve a cause better than by persecuting it and hunting it down— This—is what I have done.⁷⁷ A. Critique of Ideals 330 (1886-1887) To tackle this in such a way as to abolish the word “ideal”: critique of desiderata. 331 (1883-1888) Very few are clear as to what the standpoint of desirability, every “thus it should be but is not” or even “thus it should have been,” comprises: a condemnation of the total course of things. For in this course nothing exists in isolation: the smallest things bear the greatest, upon your little wrongful act stands the entire structure of the future, every critique of the smallest thing also condemns the whole. Now, granted that the moral norm, even as Kant understood it, has never been completely fulfilled and remains suspended over actuality as a kind of beyond without ever falling down into it, then morality would contain a judgment concerning the whole, which, however, still permits the question: whence does it derive the right to this judgment? How does the part come to sit as judge over the whole?— And if this moral judging and dissatisfaction with actuality were in fact, as has been suggested, an ineradicable instinct, might this instinct not be one of the ineradicable stupidities and immodesties of our species?— But in saying this we do that which we censure; the standpoint of desirability, of unauthorized playing-the-judge, is part of the character of the course of things, as is every injustice and imperfection—it is precisely our concept of “perfection” which is never satisfied. Every drive that desires to be satisfied expresses its dissatisfaction with the present state of things: what? is the whole perhaps composed of dissatisfied parts, which all have desiderata in their heads? is the “course of things” perhaps precisely this “away from here? away from actuality!” eternal dissatisfaction itself? is desirability perhaps the driving force itself? is it—deus?⁷⁸ * It seems to me important that one should get rid of the all, the unity, some force, something unconditioned; otherwise one will never cease regarding it as the highest court of appeal and baptizing it “God.” One must shatter the all; unlearn respect for the all; take what we have given to the unknown and the whole and give it back to what is nearest, what is ours. When, e.g., Kant says: “Two things remain forever worthy of reverence” (conclusion of the [Critique of] Practical Reason)—today we should sooner say: “Digestion is more venerable.” The all would always bring the old problems with it— “How is evil possible?” etc. Therefore: there is no all, there is no great sensorium or inventarium or storehouse of force.

332 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

A man as he ought to be: that sounds to us as insipid as “a tree as it ought to be.”⁸⁰ 333 (1883-1888) Ethics: or “philosophy of desirability.”— “Things ought to be different,” “things shall be different”: dissatisfaction would thus be the germ of ethics. One could rescue oneself from it, firstly by selecting states in which one did not have this feeling; secondly by grasping the presumption and stupidity of it: for to desire that something should be different from what it is means to desire that everything should be different—it involves a condemnatory critique of the whole.⁸¹ But life itself is such a desire! To ascertain what is, as it is, seems something unspeakably higher and more serious than any “thus it ought to be,” because the latter, as a piece of human critique and presumption, appears ludicrous from the start. It expresses a need that desires that the structure of the world should correspond with our human well-being; also the will to bring this about as far as possible. On the other hand, it is only this desire “thus it ought to be” that has called forth that other desire to know what is. For the knowledge of what is, is a consequence of that question: “How? is it possible? why precisely so?” Wonder at the disagreement between our desires and the course of the world has led to our learning to know the course of the world. But perhaps the case is different: perhaps that “thus it ought to be” is our desire to overcome the world—

334 (March-June 1888)

Today, when every “man ought to be thus and thus” is spoken with a grain of irony, when we are altogether convinced that, in spite of all, one will become only that which one is (in spite of all: that means education, instruction, milieu, chance, and accident), we have learned to reverse cause and consequence in a curious way in moral matters—nothing perhaps distinguishes us more completely from the old believers in morality. We no longer say, e.g.: “Vice is the cause that a man also goes to ruin physiologically”; and just as little: “A man prospers through virtue, it brings long life and happiness.” Our view is rather that vice and virtue are not causes but only consequences. One becomes a decent man because one is a decent man: i.e., because one was born a capitalist of good instincts and prosperous circumstances— If one comes into the world poor, of parents who have squandered everything and saved nothing, one is “incorrigible,” which means ripe for prison or the madhouse— Today we no longer know how to separate moral and physiological degeneration: the former is merely a symptom-complex of the latter; one is necessarily bad, just as one is necessarily ill— Bad: here the word expresses a certain incapacity associated physiologically with the degenerating type: e.g., weakness of will, insecure and even multiple “personality,” inability to resist reacting to a stimulus and to “control” oneself, constraint before every kind of suggestion from the will of another. Vice is not a cause; vice is a consequence— Vice is a somewhat arbitrarily limited concept designed to express in one word certain consequences of physiological degeneration. A universal proposition such as Christianity teaches—“Man is evil”—would be justified if one were justified in taking the degenerate type as the normal type of man. But perhaps this is an exaggeration. To be sure, the proposition is correct wherever Christianity prospers and stays on top: for that demonstrates a morbid soil, a field for degeneration.

335 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

One cannot have too much respect for man when one sees how well he understands how to fight his way through, to endure, to turn circumstances to his own use, to overthrow his adversaries; but when one looks at his desires he appears the absurdest of animals— It is as if he required a playground of cowardice, laziness, weakness, lusciousness, submissiveness for the recreation of his strong and manly virtues: observe human desiderata, his “ideals.” Desiring man recovers from the eternally valuable in him, from his deeds: he employs nothingness, the absurd, the valueless, the childish for his recovery. The spiritual poverty and lack of inventiveness of this inventive and resourceful animal are terrible. The “ideal” is, as it were, the penalty man pays for the tremendous expenditure he has to meet in all actual and pressing tasks. When reality ceases, dream, weariness, weakness come along: “the ideal” is simply a form of dream, weariness, weakness— The strongest and the most powerless natures become equal when this condition overtakes them: they deify the cessation of work, of war, of passion, of tension, of oppositions, of “reality” in summa—the struggle for knowledge, the exertion of knowledge. “Innocence”: that is their name for the ideal state of stupefaction; “blessedness”: the ideal state of sloth; “love”: the ideal state of the herd animal that no longer wants to have enemies. Therewith one has raised everything that debases and lowers man to an ideal.⁸⁴

336 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

Desire magnifies that which one desires; it grows even by not being fulfilled—the greatest ideas are those that have been created by the most violent and protracted desires. The more our desire for a thing grows, the more value we ascribe to that thing:⁸⁵ if “moral values” have become the highest values, this betrays the fact that the moral ideal has been the least fulfilled (—to that extent it represented a “beyond all suffering,” as a means to blessedness). Mankind has embraced, with ever-increasing ardor, nothing but clouds: finally it called its despair, its impotence “God”— 337 (1887-1888) Naiveté in respect of ultimate “desiderata”—while one does not know the “why” of mankind.

338 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

What is the counterfeiting aspect of morality?— It pretends to know something, namely what “good and evil” is. That means wanting to know why mankind is here, its goal, its destiny. That means wanting to know that mankind has a goal, a destiny—

339 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The very obscure and arbitrary idea that mankind has a single task to perform, that it is moving as a whole toward some goal, is still very young. Perhaps we shall be rid of it again before it becomes a “fixed idea”— This mankind is not a whole: it is an inextricable multiplicity of ascending and descending life-processes—it does not have a youth followed by maturity and finally by old age; the strata are twisted and entwined together—and in a few millennia there may still be even younger types of man than we can show today. Decadence, on the other hand, belongs to all epochs of mankind: refuse and decaying matter are found everywhere; it is one of life’s processes to exclude the forms of decline and decay.⁸⁷ * When Christian prejudice was a power, this question did not exist: meaning lay in the salvation of the individual soul; whether mankind could endure for a long or a short time did not come into consideration. The best Christians desired that it should end as soon as possible—concerning that which was needful to the individual there was no doubt— The task of every present individual was the same as for a future individual in any kind of future: value, meaning, domain of values were fixed, unconditional, eternal, one with God— That which deviated from this eternal type was sinful, devilish, condemned— For each soul, the gravitational center of valuation was placed within itself: salvation or damnation! The salvation of the immortal soul! Extremest form of personalization— For every soul there was only one perfecting; only one ideal; only one way to redemption— Extremest form of equality of rights, tied to an optical magnification of one’s own importance to the point of insanity— Nothing but insanely important souls, revolving about themselves with a frightful fear— * No man believes now in this absurd self-inflation: and we have sifted our wisdom through a sieve of contempt. Nevertheless, the optical habit of seeking the value of man in his approach to an ideal man remains undisturbed: fundamentally, one upholds the perspective of personalization as well as equality of rights before the ideal. In summa: one believes one knows what the ultimate desideratum is with regard to the ideal man— This belief, however, is only the consequence of a dreadful deterioration through the Christian ideal: as one at once discovers with every careful examination of the “ideal type.” One believes one knows, first that an approach to one type is desirable; secondly, that one knows what this type is like; thirdly, that every deviation from this type is a regression, an inhibition, a loss of force and power in man— To dream of conditions in which this perfect man will be in the vast majority even our socialists, even the Utilitarians have not gone farther than this — In this way a goal seems to have entered the development of mankind: at any rate, the belief in progress towards the ideal is the only form in which a goal in history is thought

of today. In summa: one has transferred the arrival of the “kingdom of God” into the future, on earth, in human form—but fundamentally one has held fast to the belief in the old ideal—

340 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The more concealed forms of the cult of the Christian moral ideal.— The insipid and cowardly concept “nature” devised by nature enthusiasts (—without any instinct for what is fearful, implacable and cynical in even the “most beautiful” aspects), a kind of attempt to read moral Christian “humanity” into nature— Rousseau’s concept of nature, as if “nature” were freedom, goodness, innocence, fairness, justice, an idyl—still a cult of Christian morality fundamentally— Collect together passages to see what the poets really admired in, e g, high mountains, etc.— What Goethe wanted from them—why he admired Spinoza—. Complete ignorance the presupposition for this cult— The insipid and cowardly concept “man” à la Comte and Stuart Mill, perhaps even the object of a cult— It is still the cult of Christian morality under a new name— The freethinkers, e g., Guyau. The insipid and cowardly concept “art” as sympathy with all that suffers and is ill-constituted (even history, e g, Thierry’s) : it is still the cult of the Christian moral ideal. And now, as for the entire socialist ideal. nothing but a clumsy misunderstanding of that Christian moral ideal.

341 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The origin of the ideal. Investigation of the soil in which it grows. a. Proceeding from the “aesthetic” states, in which the world is seen fuller, rounder and more perfect—: the pagan ideal: self-affirmation predominates (one bestows—). The highest type: the classical ideal—as the expression of the well-constitutedness of all the chief instincts. Therein the highest style: the grand style. Expression of the “will to power” itself. The instinct that is most feared dares to acknowledge itself. b. Proceeding from states in which the world is seen emptier, paler, more diluted, in which “spiritualization” and nonsensuality assume the rank of perfection, in which the brutal, the animalic-direct, the proximate are most avoided (—one removes, one chooses—) : the “sage,” the “angel,” priestly = virginal = ignorant, physiological characteristics of idealists of this sort—: the anemic ideal. Under certain circumstances it can be the ideal of those who represent the first ideal, the pagan (thus Goethe sees his “saint” in Spinoza). c. Proceeding from states in which we find the world more absurd, worse, poorer, more deceptive than we suppose or desire can be consistent with embodying the ideal (—one negates, one destroys—) : the projection of the ideal into the antinatural, anti-actual, illogical; the state of him who thus judges (—the “impoverishment” of the world as consequence of suffering: one takes, one no longer gives—) : the antinatural ideal. (The Christian ideal is an intermediate form between the second and third, now with the former, now with the latter predominating.) The three ideals: a. either a strengthening of life (—pagan) or b. a dilution of life (anemic) or c. a denial of life (—antinatural). The state of “deification” is felt: in the greatest abundance—in the most fastidious selectivity—in contempt for and destruction of life.

342 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

a. The consistent type. Here it is grasped that one must not hate even evil, that one must not oppose it, that one must not make war even against oneself; that one should not merely acquiesce in the suffering that such a way of life entails; that one should live entirely in positive feelings; that one should take the side of one's opponent in word and deed; that through a superintention of the peaceable, good-natured, conciliatory, helpful, and loving states one impoverishes the soil in which other states grow—that one requires a perpetual way of living. What is achieved here?—The Buddhist type or the perfect cow. This standpoint is possible only when no moral fanaticism prevails, i.e., when evil is hated, not for its own sake, but only because it opens the way to states that are harmful to us (unrest, work, care, entanglements, dependence). This is the Buddhist standpoint: here sin is not hated, here the concept “sin” is lacking. * b. The inconsistent type. One wages war against evil—one believes that war for the sake of goodness does not have the moral consequences or effect on the character that war otherwise brings with it (and owing to which one detests it as evil). In fact, such a war against evil does much more fundamental harm than any kind of hostility of one person against another; and usually “the person” is reinterpolated as the opponent, at least in imagination (the devil, evil spirits, etc.). A hostile attitude of watching and spying on everything in us that is bad and might have a bad origin ends in a most tormented and anxious constitution: so that “miracles,” reward, ecstasy, transcendent solutions now become desirable—The Christian type: or the perfect bigot. * c. The stoical type. Firmness, self-control, imperturbability, peace as the inflexibility of a protracted will—profound quiet, the defensive state, the fortress, a warrior's mistrustfulness—firmness of principle; the union of will and knowledge; respect for oneself. Hermit type. The perfect “ox.” 343 (1883-1888) An ideal that wants to prevail or assert itself seeks to support itself (a) by a spurious origin, (b) by a pretended relationship with powerful ideals already existing, (c) by the thrill of mystery, as if a power that cannot be questioned spoke through it, (d) by defamation of ideals that oppose it, (e) by a mendacious doctrine of the advantages it brings with it, e.g., happiness, repose of soul, peace or the assistance of a powerful God, etc.—Toward a psychology of the idealist: Carlyle, Schiller, Michelet. If one discovers all the defensive and protective measures by which an ideal maintains itself, is it then refuted? It has employed the means by which all living things live and grow—they are one and all “immoral.” My insight: all the forces and drives by virtue of which life and growth exist lie under the ban of morality: morality as the instinct to deny life. One must destroy morality if one is to liberate life.

344 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Not to know oneself: prudence of the idealist. The idealist: a creature that has good reasons to be in the dark about itself and is prudent enough to be in the dark about these reasons too. 345 (1885-1886) Tendency of moral development.— Everyone desires that no doctrine or valuation of things should come into favor but that through which he himself prospers. The basic tendency of the weak and mediocre of all ages is, consequently, to weaken and pull down the stronger: chief means, the moral judgment. The attitude of the stronger toward the weaker is branded; the higher states of the stronger acquire an evil name. The struggle of the many against the few, the commonplace against the rare, the weak against the strong—one of the subtlest interruptions of this struggle occurs when the choice, subtle, more fastidious present themselves as the weak and repudiate the coarser means of power—

346 (March-June 1888)

The pretended pure drive after knowledge in all philosophers is dictated by their moral “truths”—is only apparently independent— The “moral truths,” “thus one ought to act,” are merely forms of consciousness of a tired instinct “thus and thus one does act among us.” The “ideal” is supposed to restore and strengthen an instinct; it flatters man to be obedient where he is only an automaton.

347 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Morality as a means of seduction.— “Nature is good, for a wise and good God is its cause. Who, then, is responsible for the ‘corruption of mankind’? Its tyrants and seducers, the ruling orders—they must be destroyed”—: Rousseau’s logic (compare Pascal’s logic, which lays the responsibility on original sin). Compare the related logic of Luther. In both cases a pretext is sought to introduce an insatiable thirst for revenge as a moral-religious duty. Hatred for the ruling order seeks to sanctify itself— (the “sinfulness of Israel”: foundation of the power of the priest). Compare the related logic of Paul. It is always God’s cause in which these reactions come forth, the cause of right, of humanity, etc. In the case of Christ, the rejoicing of the people appears as the cause of his execution; an anti-priestly movement from the first. Even in the case of the anti-Semites it is still the same artifice: to visit condemnatory judgments upon one’s opponent and to reserve to oneself the role of retributive justice.

348 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Course of the struggle: the fighter tries to transform his opponent into his antithesis—in imagination naturally. He tries to have faith in himself to such a degree that he may have courage for the “good cause” (as if he were the good cause); as if his opponent were attacking reason, taste, virtue— The belief he needs as the strongest means of defense and attack is a belief in himself, which, however, knows how to misunderstand itself as belief in God:— never to imagine the advantages and utility of victory, but always victory for the sake of victory, as “the victory of God”—. Every little community (even an individual) that finds itself involved in struggle tries to convince itself: “We have good taste, good judgment, and virtue on our side.”— The struggle compels to such an exaggeration of self-esteem—

349 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

Whatever kind of bizarre ideal one may follow (e.g., as “Christian” or as “free spirit” or as “immoralist” or as Reichsdeutscher—), one should not demand that it be the ideal: for one therewith takes from it its privileged character. One should have it in order to distinguish oneself, not in order to level oneself. How comes it, this notwithstanding, that most idealists at once propagandize for their ideal, as if they could have no right to the ideal if everyone did not recognize it?— This, e.g., is what all those brave little women do who permit themselves to learn Latin and mathematics. What compels them? The instinct of the herd, I fear, terror of the herd: they fight for the “emancipation of women” because it is under the form of a generous activity, under the banner of “For others,” that they can most prudently forward their own little private separatism. Prudence of idealists to be only missionaries and “representatives” of an ideal: they “transfigure” themselves in the eyes of those who believe in disinterestedness and heroism. Whereas: true heroism consists, in not fighting under the banner of sacrifice, devotion, disinterestedness, but in not fighting at all— “This is what I am; this is what I want:— you can go to hell!”—

350 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Every ideal presupposes love and hate, reverence and contempt. Either the positive feeling is the primum mobile or the negative feeling is. Hate and contempt are, e.g., the primum mobile in all resentment ideals. B. Critique of the “Good Man,” the Saint, etc.

351 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The “good man.” Or: the hemiplegia of virtue.— For every strong and natural species of man, love and hate, gratitude and revenge, good nature and anger, affirmative acts and negative acts, belong together. One is good on condition one also knows how to be evil; one is evil because otherwise one would not understand how to be good. Whence, then, comes the sickness and ideological unnaturalness that rejects this doubleness—that teaches that it is a higher thing to be efficient on only one side? Whence comes the hemiplegia of virtue, the invention of the good man?— The demand is that man should castrate himself of those instincts with which he can be an enemy, can cause harm, can be angry, can demand revenge— This unnaturalness corresponds, then, to that dualistic conception of a merely good and a merely evil creature (God, spirit, man); in the former are summarized all the positive, in the latter all the negative forces, intentions, states.— Such a manner of valuing believes itself to be “idealistic”; it does not doubt that, in the conception of “the good,” it has posited a supreme desideratum. At its peak, it imagines a state in which all that is evil is annulled and in which only good creatures actually remain. It does not even consider it settled that this antithesis of good and evil is conditional on the existence of both; on the contrary, the latter should vanish and the former remain, the one has a right to exist, the other ought not to be there at all— What is it really that desires this?— Much labor has been expended in all ages, and especially in the Christian ages, to reduce mankind to this half-sided efficiency, to the “good”: even today there is no lack of those deformed and weakened by the church for whom this object coincides with “humanization” in general, or with the “will of God,” or with “salvation of the soul” The essential demand here is that mankind should do nothing evil, that it should under no circumstances do harm or desire to do harm. The way to achieve this is: the castration of all possibility of enmity, the unhinging of all the instincts of resentment, “peace of soul” as a chronic disease. This mode of thought, with which a definite type of man is bred, starts from an absurd presupposition: it takes good and evil for realities that contradict one another (not as complementary value concepts, which would be the truth), it advises taking the side of the good, it desires that the good should renounce and oppose the evil down to its ultimate roots—it therewith actually denies life, which has in all its instincts both Yes and No Not that it grasps this: it dreams, on the contrary, that it is getting back to wholeness, to unity, to strength of life: it thinks it will be a state of redemption when the inner anarchy, the unrest between those opposing value drives, is at last put an end to.— Perhaps there has never before been a more dangerous ideology, a greater mischief in psychologicis, than this will to good: one has reared the most repellent type, the unfree man, the bigot; one has taught that only as a bigot is one on the right path to god-hood,

only the bigot's way is God's way. And even here, life is still in the right—life, which does not know how to separate Yes from No—: what good is it to hold with all one's strength that war is evil, not to do harm, not to desire to negate! one wages war nonetheless! one cannot do otherwise! The good man who has renounced evil, afflicted, as seems to him desirable, with that hemiplegia of virtue, in no way ceases to wage war, have enemies, say No and act No. The Christian, for example, hates "sin"! Precisely because of his faith in a moral antithesis of good and evil the world has become for him overfull of things that must be hated and eternally combated. "The good man" sees himself as if surrounded by evil, and under the continual onslaught of evil his eye grows keener, he discovers evil in all his dreams and desires; and so he ends, quite reasonably, by considering nature evil, mankind corrupt, goodness an act of grace (that is, as impossible for man). In summa: he denies life, he grasps that when good is the supreme value it condemns life— Therewith he ought to consider his ideology of good and evil as refuted. But one cannot refute an illness. And so he conceives another life!—

352 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The concept of power, whether of a god or of a man, always includes both the ability to help and the ability to harm. Thus it is with the Arabs; thus with the Hebrews. Thus with all strong races. It is a fateful step when one separates the power for the one from the power for the other into a dualism— In this way, morality becomes the poisoner of life—

353 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Toward a critique of the good man.— Integrity, dignity, sense of duty, justice, humanity, honesty, straightness, good conscience— are certain qualities really affirmed and approved for their own sake with these well-sounding words? or is it a case of qualities and states, in themselves of no particular value, being moved into a certain light in which they acquire value? Does the value of these qualities reside in them or in the use and advantage to which they lead (appear to lead, are expected to lead)? Naturally, I do not mean by this an antithesis between ego and alter in the judgment: the question is whether these qualities are supposed to have value on account of their consequences, either for the bearer of these qualities or for the environment, for society, for “humanity”: or whether they have value in themselves— In other words: is it utility that bids one condemn, combat, deny the opposite qualities (—untrustworthiness, falseness, perversity, lack of self-confidence, inhumanity—)? Is the essence of such qualities condemned, or only their consequences?— In other words: would it be desirable that men with these latter qualities should not exist?— In any event, that is what is believed— But here lies the error, the short-sightedness, the narrow-mindedness of nook egoism. Otherwise expressed: would it be desirable to create conditions in which all the advantage would be with the righteous—so that the opposite natures and instincts would be discouraged and slowly die out? This is at bottom a question of taste and of aesthetics: would it be desirable that the “most respectable,” i.e., most tedious, species of man should survive? the square,⁹² the virtuous, the worthies, the good people, the straight, the “oxen”?⁹³ If one imagines the tremendous abundance of the “others” gone, then even the righteous no longer has a right to existence: he is no longer necessary—and here one grasps that it is only coarse utility that has brought such an insufferable virtue into honor. Perhaps desirability lies on precisely the other side: to create conditions in which the “righteous man” is reduced to the modest position of a “useful tool”—as the “ideal herd animal,” at best herdsman: in short, conditions in which he no longer stands among the higher orders which require other qualities.

354 (March-June 1888)

The “good man” as tyrant.— Man has repeated the same mistake over and over again: he has made a means to life into a standard of life; instead of discovering the standard in the highest enhancement of life itself, in the problem of growth and exhaustion, he has employed the means to a quite distinct kind of life to exclude all other forms of life, in short to criticize and select life. I.e., man finally loves the means for their own sake and forgets they are means: so that they enter his consciousness as aims, as standards for aims—i.e., a certain species of man treats the conditions of its existence as conditions which ought to be imposed as a law, as “truth,” “good,” “perfection”: it tyrannizes— It is a form of faith, of instinct, that a species of man fails to perceive its conditionality, its relativity to other species. At least, it seems to be all over for a species of man (people, races) when it becomes tolerant, allows equal rights and no longer thinks of wanting to be master— 355 (1885-1886) “All good people are weak: they are good because they are not strong enough to be evil”⁹⁴—the Latuka chieftain Comorro told Baker. * “The faint-hearted know no misfortune”—says a Russian proverb. 356 (1887-1888) Modest, industrious, benevolent, temperate: is that how you would have men? good men? But to me that seems only the ideal slave, the slave of the future.

357 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The metamorphoses of slavery; its disguise under the cloak of religion; its transfiguration through morality. 358 (1887-1888) The ideal slave (the “good man”).— He who cannot posit himself as a goal, not posit any goals for himself whatever, bestows honor upon selflessness—instinctively. Everything persuades him to this: his prudence, his experience, his vanity. And even faith is a form of selflessness. * Atavism: wonderful feeling to be able to obey unconditionally for once. * Industry, modesty, benevolence, temperance are just so many hindrances to a sovereign disposition, great inventiveness, heroic purposiveness, noble being-for-oneself. * It is not a matter of going ahead (—for then one is at best a herdsman, i.e., the herd’s chief requirement), but of being able to go it alone, of being able to be different.

359 (Spring-Fall 1887)

One must reckon up what had been accumulated as a consequence of the highest moral idealism: how almost all other values had crystallized around the ideal. This proves that it has been desired longest and strongest—that is has not been attained: otherwise it would have disappointed (or would have been followed by a more moderate valuation).⁹⁵ The saint as the most powerful type of man—: it is this idea that has elevated so high the value of moral perfection. One must imagine the whole of knowledge laboring to prove that the moral man is the most powerful, most godlike.— The overcoming of the senses, the desires— everything inspired fear; the antinatural appeared as the supernatural, as something from the beyond— 360 (1883-1888) Francis of Assisi: in love, popular, a poet, combats the order of rank among souls in favor of the lowliest. Denial of the hierarchy of souls—“all equal before God.” The popular ideals: the good man, the selfless man, the saint, the sage, the just man. O Marcus Aurelius!

361 (Spring-Fall 1887)

I have declared war on the anemic Christian ideal (together with what is closely related to it), not with the aim of destroying it but only of putting an end to its tyranny and clearing the way for new ideals, for more robust ideals— The continuance of the Christian ideal is one of the most desirable things there are— even for the sake of the ideals that want to stand beside it and perhaps above it— they must have opponents, strong opponents, if they are to become strong.— Thus we immoralists require the power of morality: our drive of self-preservation wants our opponents to retain their strength—it only wants to become master over them.⁹⁶ C. Disparagement of the So-Called Evil Qualities 362 (1885)

Egoism and its problem! The Christian gloominess in La Rochefoucauld which extracted egoism from everything and thought he had thereby reduced the value of things and of virtues! To counter that, I at first sought to prove that there could not be anything other than egoism—that in men whose ego is weak and thin the power of great love also grows weak—that the greatest lovers are so from the strength of their ego—that love is an expression of egoism, etc. In fact, the false valuation is aimed at the interests: (1) of those who are helped and aided, the herd; (2) it contains a pessimistic mistrustfulness of the basis of life; (3) it would like to deny the most splendid and best-constituted men; fear; (4) it wants to aid the subjected to their rights against their conquerors; (5) it brings with it a universal dishonesty, and precisely among the most valuable men.

363 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Man is an indifferent egoist: even the cleverest thinks his habits more important than his advantage. 364 (1884) Egoism! But no one has yet asked: what kind of ego? On the contrary, everyone unconsciously thinks every ego equal to every other ego. This is the consequence of the slaves' theory of suffrage universal and "equality." 365 (1884) The actions of a higher man are indescribably complex in their motivation: any such word as "pity" says nothing whatever. The most essential thing is the feeling "Who am I? who is the other in relation to me?"—Value judgments are continually at work. 366 (1885-1886) That the history of all phenomena of morality could be simplified in the way Schopenhauer believed—namely, so that pity is to be discovered as the root of all moral impulse hitherto—only a thinker denuded of all historical instinct, and one who had eluded in the strangest way even that strong schooling in history undergone by the Germans from Herder to Hegel, could have attained to this degree of absurdity and naiveté. 367 (1885) My kind of "pity."—This is a feeling for which I find no name adequate: I sense it when I see precious capabilities squandered, e.g., at the sight of Luther: what force and what insipid backwoodsman problems! (at a time when in France the bold and light-hearted skepticism of a Montaigne was already possible!) Or when I see anyone halted, as a result of some stupid accident, at something less than he might have become. Or especially at the idea of the lot of mankind, as when I observe with anguish and contempt the politics of present-day Europe, which is, under all circumstances, also working at the web of the future of all men. Yes, what could not become of "man," if——! This is a kind of "compassion" although there is really no "passion" I share.⁹⁸ 368 (1883-1888) Pity a squandering of feeling, a parasite harmful to moral health,⁹⁹ "it cannot possibly be our duty to increase the evil in the world." If one does good merely out of pity, it is oneself one really does good to, and not the other. Pity does not depend upon maxims but upon affects;¹⁰⁰ it is pathological. The suffering of others infects us, pity is an infection. 369 (1885-1886) No egoism at all exists that remains within itself and does not encroach—consequently, that "allowable," "morally indifferent" egoism of which you speak does not exist at all. "One furthers one's ego always at the expense of others;" "Life always lives at the expense of other life"—he who does not grasp this has not taken even the first step toward honesty with himself.

370 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The “subject” is only a fiction: the ego of which one speaks when one censures egoism does not exist at all. 371 (1885-1886) The “ego”—which is not one with the central government of our nature!—4s, indeed, only a conceptual synthesis—thus there are no actions prompted by “egoism” 372 (1883-1888) As every drive lacks intelligence, the viewpoint of “utility” cannot exist for it. Every drive, in as much as it is active, sacrifices force and other drives: finally it is checked; otherwise it would destroy everything through its excessiveness. Therefore: the “un-egoistic,” self-sacrificing, imprudent, is nothing special—it is common to all the drives—they do not consider the advantage of the whole ego (because they do not consider at all!), they act contrary to our advantage, against the ego: and often for the ego—innocent in both cases!

373 (March-June 1888)

Origin of moral values.¹⁰¹— Egoism is of as much value as the physiological value of him who possesses it. Every individual consists of the whole course of evolution (and not, as morality imagines, only of something that begins at birth). If he represents the ascending course of mankind, then his value is in fact extraordinary; and extreme care may be taken over the preservation and promotion of his development. (It is concern for the future promised him that gives the well-constituted individual such an extraordinary right to egoism.) If he represents the descending course, decay, chronic sickening, then he has little value: and the first demand of fairness is for him to take as little space, force, and sunshine as possible away from the well-constituted. In this case, it is the task of society to suppress egoism (—which sometimes expresses itself in absurd, morbid and rebellious ways), whether it be a question of individuals or of whole decaying and atrophying classes of people. A doctrine and religion of “love,” of suppression of self-affirmation, of patience, endurance, helpfulness, of cooperation in word and deed, can be of the highest value within such classes, even from the point of view of the rulers: for it suppresses feelings of rivalry, of resentment, of envy—the all too natural feelings of the underprivileged—it even deifies a life of slavery, subjection, poverty, sickness, and inferiority for them under the ideal of humility and obedience. This explains why the ruling classes (or races) and individuals have at all times upheld the cult of selflessness, the gospel of the lowly, the “God on the cross.” The preponderance of an altruistic mode of valuation is the consequence of an instinct that one is ill-constituted. The value judgment here is at bottom: “I am not worth much”: a merely physiological value judgment; even more clearly: the feeling of impotence, the absence of the great affirmative feelings of power (in muscles, nerves, ganglia). This value judgment is translated into a moral or a religious judgment, according to the culture of this class (—the predominance of religious and moral judgments is always a sign of a lower culture—) : it seeks to establish itself by relating to spheres in which it recognizes the concept “value” in general. The interpretation by means of which the Christian sinner believes he understands himself is an attempt to justify his lack of power and self-confidence: he would rather consider himself guilty than feel bad for no reason: it is a symptom of decay to require interpretations of this sort at all. In other cases, the underprivileged man seeks the reason not in his “guilt” (as the Christian does), but in society: the socialist, the anarchist, the nihilist—in as much as they find their existence something of which someone must be guilty, they are still the closest relations of the Christian, who also believes he can better endure his sense of sickness and ill-constitutedness by finding someone whom he can make responsible for it. The instinct of revenge and resentment appears

here in both cases as a means of enduring, as the instinct of self-preservation: just as is the preference for altruistic theory and practice. Hatred of egoism, whether it be one's own (as with Christians) or another's (as with socialists), is thus revealed as a value judgment under the predominating influence of revenge; on the other hand, as an act of prudence for the self-preservation of the suffering by an enhancement of their feelings of cooperation and solidarity— Finally, even that release of resentment in the judging, rejecting, punishing of egoism (one's own or another's) is also, as already indicated, an instinct of self-preservation on the part of the underprivileged. In summa: the cult of altruism is a specific form of egoism that regularly appears under certain physiological conditions. When the socialist with a fine indignation demands "justice," "right," "equal rights," he is merely acting under the impress of his inadequate culture that cannot explain why he is suffering: on the other hand, he enjoys himself; if he felt better he would refrain from crying out: he would then find pleasure in other things. The same applies to the Christian: he condemns, disparages, curses the "world"—himself not excluded. But that is no reason for taking his clamor seriously. In both cases we are in the presence of invalids who feel better for crying out, for whom defamation is a relief.

374 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

Every society has the tendency to reduce its opponents to caricatures—at least in imagination—and, as it were, to starve them. Such a caricature is, e.g., our “criminal.” Within the aristocratic Roman order of values, the Jew was reduced to a caricature. Among artists, the “philistine and bourgeois” become caricatures; among the pious, the godless; among aristocrats, the man of the people. Among immoralists it is the moralist: Plato, for example, becomes a caricature in my hands. 375 (1883-1888) All the drives and powers that morality praises seem to me to be essentially the same as those it defames and rejects: e.g., justice as will to power, will to truth as a tool of the will to power. 376 (1883-1888) Man’s growing inwardness. Inwardness grows as powerful drives that have been denied outward release by the establishment of peace and society seek compensation by turning inward in concert with the imagination. The thirst for enmity, cruelty, revenge, violence turns back, is repressed;102 in the desire for knowledge there is avarice and conquest; in the artist there reappears the repressed power to dissimulate and lie; the drives are transformed into demons whom one fights, etc. 377 (1883-1888) Falsity.— Every sovereign instinct has the others for its tools, retainers, flatterers: it never lets itself be called by its ugly name: and it countenances no praise in which it is not also praised indirectly. All praise and blame in general crystallizes around every sovereign instinct to form a rigorous order and etiquette. This is one of the causes of falsity. Every instinct that struggles for mastery but finds itself under a yoke requires for itself, as strengthening and as support for its self-esteem, all the beautiful names and recognized values: so, as a rule, it ventures forth under the name of the “master” it is combatting and from whom it wants to get free (e.g., the fleshly desires or the desires for power under the dominion of Christian values).— This is the other cause of falsity. Perfect naiveté reigns in both cases: the falsity does not become conscious. It is a sign of a broken instinct when man sees the driving force and its “expression” (“the mask”) as separate things—a sign of self-contradiction, and victorious far less often. Absolute innocence in bearing, word, affect, a “good conscience” in falsity, the certainty with which one grasps the greatest and most splendid words and postures—all this is necessary for victory. In the other case: when one has extreme clearsightedness one needs the genius of the actor and tremendous training in self-control if one is to achieve victory. That is why priests are the most skillful conscious hypocrites; then princes, whom rank and ancestry have endowed with a kind of acting ability. Thirdly, men of society, diplomats. Fourthly, women. Basic idea: falsity seems so profound, so omnisided, the will so clearly opposed to direct self-knowledge and the calling of things by their right names, that it is very highly probable that truth, will to truth is really something else and only a disguise. (The need for faith is the greatest

brake-shoe on truthfulness.) 378 (1883-1888) “Thou shalt not lie”: one demands truthfulness. But acknowledgement of the factual (refusal to let oneself be lied to) has been greatest precisely among liars: they have recognized that just this popular “truthfulness” is not a fact. What is said is always too much or too little: the demand that one should denude oneself with every word one says is a piece of naiveté. One says what one thinks, one is “truthful,” only under certain conditions: namely, that one is understood (*inter pares*),¹⁰⁴ and understood with good will (once again *inter pares*). One conceals oneself in presence of the unfamiliar: and he who wants to attain something says what he would like to have thought of him, but not what he thinks. (“The powerful always lie.”)

379 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The great nihilistic counterfeiting through artful misuse of moral values: a. Love as depersonalization; also pity. b. Only the most depersonalized intellect (“the philosopher”) knows the truth, “the true being and nature of things.” c. The genius, the great human beings, are great because they do not seek their own advantage: the value of a man increases in proportion as he denies himself. d. Art as the work of the “pure free-willed subject”; misunderstanding of “objectivity.” e. Happiness as the end of life. virtue as means to an end. The pessimistic condemnation of life by Schopenhauer is a moral one. Transference of herd standards into the realm of metaphysics. The “individuum” meaningless, necessitating an origin in the “in-itself” (and an explanation of his existence as an “aberration”); parents only “accidental cause.”— We are paying for the fact that science has not understood the individuum: he comprises the entirety of life hitherto in one development, and is not its result.

380 (Spring-Fall 1887)

decline of a people and corruption;105 rise of a people and virtue; zenith of a people (“its culture”) as consequence of moral elevation. one desires that faith should be the distinguishing mark of the great: but slackness, skepticism, “immorality,” the right to throw off a faith, belong to greatness (Caesar, also Homer, Aristophanes, Leonardo, Goethe). One always suppresses the main thing, their “freedom of will”—

381 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Great lie in history: as if the corruption of the church were the cause of the Reformation! Only pretext and self-deception on the part of the instigators—strong needs were present whose brutality very much required a spiritual cloak.

106

382 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

Schopenhauer interpreted high intellectuality as liberation from the will; he did not want to see the freedom from moral prejudice which is part of the emancipation of the great spirit, the typical immorality of the genius; he artfully posited the only thing he held in honor, the moral value of “depersonalization,” as the condition of spiritual activity, of “objective” viewing. “Truth,” even in art, appears after the withdrawal of the will—I see a fundamentally different valuation cutting across all the moral idiosyncrasies: I know nothing of such an absurd distinction between “genius” and the moral and immoral world of the will. The moral man is a lower species than the immoral, a weaker species; indeed—he is a type in regard to morality, but not a type in himself; a copy, a good copy at best—the measure of his value lies outside him. I assess a man by the quantum of power and abundance of his will: not by its enfeeblement and extinction; I regard a philosophy which teaches denial of the will as a teaching of defamation and slander—I assess the power of a will by how much resistance, pain, torture it endures and knows how to turn to its advantage; I do not account the evil and painful character of existence a reproach to it, but hope rather that it will one day be more evil and painful than hitherto—107 The high point of the spirit imagined by Schopenhauer was to attain to the recognition that there is no meaning in anything, in short, to recognize what the good man already instinctively does—He denies the possibility of a higher kind of intellect—he took his insight for a non plus ultra. Here spirituality is placed much lower than goodness; its highest value (e.g., as art) would be to urge and prepare moral conversion: absolute domination of moral values.—Beside Schopenhauer I would characterize Kant: nothing Greek, absolutely antihistorical (his passage on the French Revolution) and a moral fanatic (Goethe’s passage on radical evil). Saintliness was in the background in his case, too. I need a critique of the saint—Hegel’s value. “Passion.”—Shopkeeper’s philosophy of Mr. Spencer; complete absence of an ideal, except that of the mediocre man. Fundamental instinctive principle of all philosophers and historians and psychologists: everything of value in man, art, history, science, religion, technology must be proved to be of moral value, morally conditioned, in aim, means and outcome. Everything understood in the light of the supreme value: e.g., Rousseau’s question concerning civilization: “Does man become better through it?”—an amusing question, since the reverse is obvious and is precisely that which speaks in favor of civilization.

383 (March-June 1888)

Religious morality.— Affect, great desire, the passion for power, love, revenge, possessions—: moralists want to extinguish and uproot them, to “purify” the soul of them. The logic is: the desires often produce great misfortune— consequently they are evil, reprehensible. A man must free himself from them: otherwise he cannot be a good man— This is the same logic as: “if thine eye offend thee, pluck it out.” In the particular case in which that dangerous “innocent from the country,” the founder of Christianity, recommended this practice to his disciples, the case of sexual excitation, the consequence is, unfortunately, not only the loss of an organ but the emasculation of a man’s character— And the same applies to the moralist’s madness that demands, instead of the restraining of the passions, their extirpation. Its conclusion is always: only the castrated man is a good man. Instead of taking into service the great sources of strength, those impetuous torrents of the soul that are so often dangerous and overwhelming, and economizing them, this most shortsighted and pernicious mode of thought, the moral mode of thought, wants to make them dry up.¹⁰⁸ 384 (1885-1886)

Overcoming of the affects?— No, if what is implied is their weakening and extirpation. But putting them into service: which may also mean subjecting them to a protracted tyranny (not only as an individual, but as a community, race, etc.). At last they are confidently granted freedom again: they love us as good servants and go voluntarily wherever our best interests lie.

385 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Moral intolerance is an expression of weakness in a man: he is afraid of his own “immorality,” he must deny his strongest drives because he does not yet know how to employ them. Thus the most fruitful regions of the earth remain uncultivated the longest:— the force is lacking that could here become master—

386 (Spring-Fall 1887)

There are very naive peoples and men who believe that continual fine weather is something desirable: even today they believe, in *rebus moralibus*,¹⁰⁹ that the “good man,” and nothing but the “good man,” is something desirable—and that the course of human evolution is directed toward the survival of the “good man” only (and that one must bend all one’s efforts in that direction—). This is in the highest degree an uneconomic thought and, as stated, the acme of naiveté, nothing but the expression of the pleasing effect produced by the “good man” (— he arouses no fear, he permits one to relax, he gives what one is able to take).¹¹⁰ From a superior viewpoint one desires the contrary: the ever-increasing dominion of evil, the growing emancipation of man from the narrow and fear-ridden bonds of morality, the increase of force, in order to press the mightiest natural powers—the affects—into service.

387 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The whole conception of an order of rank among the passions: as if the right and normal thing were for one to be guided by reason—with the passions as abnormal, dangerous, semi-animal, and, moreover, so far as their aim is concerned, nothing other than desires for pleasure— Passion is degraded (1) as if it were only in unseemly cases, and not necessarily and always, the motive force; (2) in as much as it has for its object something of no great value, amusement— The misunderstanding of passion and reason, as if the latter were an independent entity and not rather a system of relations between various passions and desires; and as if every passion did not possess its quantum of reason—

388 (Spring-Fall 1887)

How, under the impress of the ascetic morality of depersonalization, it was precisely the affects of love, goodness, pity, even those of justice, magnanimity, heroism, that were necessarily misunderstood:¹¹¹ It is richness in personality, abundance in oneself, overflowing and bestowing, instinctive good health and affirmation of oneself, that produce great sacrifice and great love: it is strong and godlike selfhood from which these affects grow, just as surely as do the desire to become master, encroachment, the inner certainty of having a right to everything. What according to common ideas are opposite dispositions are rather one disposition; and if one is not firm and brave within oneself, one has nothing to bestow and cannot stretch out one's hand to protect and support— How was one able so to transform these instincts that man thought valuable that which was directed against his self? when he sacrificed his self to another self. Oh the psychological wretchedness and mendaciousness that has hitherto laid down the law in the church and in church-infected philosophy! If man is sinful through and through, then he ought only to hate himself. Fundamentally, he would have to treat his fellow men on the same basis as he treats himself; charity needs to be justified—its justification lies in the fact that God has commanded it.— It follows from this, that all the natural instincts of man (the instinct of love, etc.) appear to be forbidden in themselves and only after they have been denied are they restored to their rights on the basis of obedience to God—Pascal, the admirable logician of Christianity, went so far! consider his relations to his sister. “Not to make oneself love”¹¹² seemed Christian to him. 389 (1883-1888) Let us consider the cost of such a moral canon (“an ideal”). (Its enemies are—well? The “egoists.”) The melancholic astuteness in self-disparagement in Europe (Pascal, La Rochefoucauld)—the inner enfeeblement, discouragement, self-vexation of the non-herd animals— the perpetual emphasizing of the qualities of mediocrity as the most valuable (modesty in rank and file, the tool-like nature)— the bad conscience associated with all that is self-glorifying and original; therefore displeasure; therefore the world of the more strongly constituted made gloomy! herd-consciousness transferred to philosophy and religion; also its timorousness. Let us leave aside the psychological impossibility of a purely selfless action!

390 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

My final proposition is: that the actual man represents a much higher value than the “desirable” man of any ideal hitherto; that all “desiderata” with reference to man have been absurd and dangerous excesses through which a single type of man tried to establish his conditions of preservation and growth as a law for all mankind; that every “desideratum” of this kind ever brought into a position of dominance has reduced the value of man, his strength, his certainty of the future; that the nook-intellectuality and poverty of spirit of man is most apparent, even today, when he desires, that man’s ability to posit values has hitherto been too little developed for him to be just, not merely to the “desirable” values, but to the real values of man; that the ideal has hitherto been the actual force for disparaging the world and man, the poisonous vapor over reality, the great seduction to nothingness— D. Critique of the Words: Improvement, Perfecting, Elevation 391 (1885-1886) Standard by which the value of moral evaluation is to be determined. The fundamental fact that has been overlooked: the contradiction between “becoming more moral” and the elevation and strengthening of the type man. Homo natura. The “will to power.”

392 (March-June 1888)

Moral values as illusory values compared with physiological values.

393 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Thought about the most universal subjects is always behind the times: the ultimate “desiderata” for mankind, for example, have never really been grasped as a problem by philosophers. They all naively postulate the “improvement” of man as if an intuition answered for us the question why we ought to “improve.” To what extent is it desirable that man should become more virtuous? or cleverer? or happier? Provided we do not already know the “wherefore” of mankind, such an outlook has no meaning; and if one desires one of these things, who knows, perhaps one is precluded from desiring the others. Is an increase in virtuousness compatible with an increase in cleverness and insight? Dubito;113 only too often I shall have occasion to show the reverse. Has virtuousness as a goal not hitherto been in the most rigorous sense incompatible with being happy? does it not, on the contrary, require misfortune, self-denial and self-mistreatment as a necessary means? And if the deepest insight were the goal, would one not then have to renounce the increase of happiness? and choose danger, adventure, mistrust, seduction as the road to insight?— And if one desires happiness, well, perhaps one has to become one of the “poor in spirit.”

394 (March-June 1888)

The universal deception and cheating in the realm of so-called moral improvement.— We do not believe that a man will become another if he is not that other already; i.e., if he is not, as is often the case, a multiplicity of persons, at least the embryos of persons. In this case, one can bring a different role into the foreground and draw “the former man” back— The aspect is changed, not the essence— That someone ceases to perform certain actions is a mere *fatum brutum* that permits the most various interpretations. It is not always the case that the habit of a certain act is broken, the ultimate reason for it removed. He who is a criminal through fate and facility unlearns nothing, but learns more and more: and a long abstinence even acts as a tonic to his talent— For society, to be sure, all that is of interest is precisely that someone no longer performs certain actions: to this end it removes him from those conditions in which he can perform certain actions; that is wiser, in any event, than to attempt the impossible, namely, to disrupt the fatality by which he is thus and thus. The church— and in this it has done nothing but succeed and inherit from the philosophy of antiquity— proceeding from a different standard and desiring to save a “soul,” the “eternal destiny” of a soul, first believes in the expiatory power of punishment and then in the obliterating power of forgiveness: both are deceptions of religious prejudice—punishment does not expiate, forgiveness does not extinguish, what is done is not undone. That someone forgets something is certainly not evidence that something has ceased to exist— A deed produces its consequences, within the man and outside the man, regardless of whether it is considered as punished, “expiated,” “forgiven” and “extinguished,” regardless of whether the church has in the meantime promoted the doer to a saint. The church believes in things that do not exist, in “souls;” it believes in effects that do not exist, in divine effects; it believes in states that do not exist, in sin, in redemption, in the salvation of the soul: it stays everywhere on the surface, at signs, gestures, words to which it gives an arbitrary meaning. It possesses a thoroughly thought-out method of psychological counterfeiting. 395 (1887-1888) —“Illness makes men better”: this famous opinion, which one encounters throughout the centuries, in the mouth of the sage as often as in the mouth and maw of the people, makes one wonder. As to whether it is valid, one would like to ask: were morality and illness originally connected, perhaps? The “improvement of man,” regarded as a whole, e.g., the undeniable softening, humanizing, mellowing of the European within the last millennium—is it perhaps the result of long hidden and mysterious suffering and failure, abstinence, stunting? Has “illness” made the European “better”? Or, in other words; is our morality—our modern sensitive European morality, which may be compared with the morality of the Chinese—the expression of a physiological regression?— For one cannot deny that every

period in history in which “man” has shown himself in exceptional splendor and power at once assumed an impetuous, dangerous, and eruptive character under which humanity fared ill; and perhaps in those cases in which it seems otherwise, all that was lacking was the courage or subtlety to take psychology into the depths and to find there, too, the universal law: “the healthier, stronger, richer, more fruitful, more enterprising a man feels, the more ‘immoral’ he will be, too.” A painful thought! in which one certainly ought not to indulge! If, however, one goes along with it for just a few moments, how astonishing the future seems then! What would then be paid for more dearly than precisely that which we are promoting with all our strength—the humanizing, the “improvement,” the growing “civilization” of man? Nothing would be more costly than virtue: for one would in the end have turned the earth into a hospital: and ultimate wisdom would be “everyone as everyone else’s nurse.” To be sure, one would then possess that much-desired “peace on earth”! But how little “delight in each other”! How little beauty, high spirits, daring, danger! How few “works” for the sake of which life on earth is worth while! And, alas, no more “deeds” whatever! All great works and deeds that have remained and have not been washed away by the waters of time— were they not all in the profoundest sense immoralities?

396 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The priests—and with them the semi-priests, the philosophers—have at all times called true any teaching whose educative effect was beneficial or seemed beneficial—which “improved.” In this they resemble a naive quack and miracle man of the people, who, because he has used a poison as a cure, denies it is a poison— “By their fruits shall ye know them—namely, our ‘truths’ ”: that has been the reasoning of the priests to this day. With fateful results, they have expended their subtlety to make the “proof of power” (or “from their fruits”) pre-eminent, even decisive, above all other forms of proof. “What makes good must be good; what is good cannot lie”—that is their relentless conclusion—: “what bears good fruit must be true: there is no other criterion of truth”— But if “making better” counts as an argument, then making worse must count as a refutation. One can prove an error to be an error by testing the lives of those who espouse it: a mistake, a vice can refute— This most indecent form of opposition, from behind and below, the doglike form of opposition, has not died out either: the priests, in so far as they are psychologists, have never discovered anything more interesting than to sniff at the secrets of their adversaries—they demonstrate their Christianity by looking about the “world” for filth. Especially with the first men of the world, with the “geniuses”: one will remember how Goethe has been attacked in Germany at all times (Klopstock and Herder were the first to provide a “good example” of this—kind sticks to kind).

397 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

One must be very immoral in order to make morals by deeds— The means of the moralist are the most terrible means that have ever been employed; he who has not the courage for immorality in deeds is fit for anything, but he is not fit to be a moralist. Morality is a menagerie; its presupposition is that iron bars can be more profitable than freedom, even for the prisoners; its other presupposition is that there exist animal-trainers who are not afraid of terrible means—who know how to handle red-hot iron. This frightful species which takes up the fight against the wild animal is called “priest.” * Man, imprisoned in an iron cage of errors, became a caricature of man, sick, wretched, ill-disposed toward himself, full of hatred for the impulses of life, full of mistrust of all that is beautiful and happy in life, a walking picture of misery: this artificial, arbitrary, recent abortion that the priests have pulled up out of their soil, the “sinner”: how shall we be able, in spite of all, to justify this phenomenon? * In order to be fair to morality, we must put two zoological concepts in its place: taming of the beast and breeding of a particular species. The priests have pretended at all times that they want to “improve”— But we others would laugh if an animal-trainer spoke of his “improved” animals. In most cases, the taming of a beast is achieved through the harming of a beast: the moral man, too, is not a better man but only a weaker one. But he is less harmful—115

398 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

What I want to make clear by all the means in my power: a. that there is no worse confusion than the confusion of breeding with taming: which is what has been done— Breeding, as I understand it, is a means of storing up the tremendous forces of mankind so that the generations can build upon the work of their forefathers—not only outwardly, but inwardly, organically growing out of them and becoming something stronger— b. that it is extraordinarily dangerous to believe that mankind as a whole will progress and grow stronger if individuals become flabby, equal, average— Mankind is an abstraction: the goal of breeding, even in the case of a single individual, can only be the stronger man (—the man without breeding is weak, extravagant, unstable—). 399 (1885-1886) These are the demands I make upon you—however ill they may sound to you: that you should undertake a critique of the moral evaluations themselves. That you should call a halt to the moral impulse, which here demands submission and not a critique, with the question: “why submission?” That you should regard this demand for a “wherefore?”, for a critique of morality, as precisely your present form of morality, as the sublimest form of morality, which does honor to you and to your age. That our honesty, our will not to deceive ourselves, must prove itself: why not?— Before what tribunal? The will not to let oneself be deceived is of different origin: a caution against being overpowered, exploited—one of life’s instincts of self-defense.116 400 (1883-1888) The three assertions: The ignoble is the higher (protest of the “common man”); the antinatural is the higher (protest of the underprivileged); the average is the higher (protest of the herd, of the “mediocre”). Thus in the history of morality a will to power finds expression, through which now the slaves and oppressed, now the ill-constituted and those who suffer from themselves, now the mediocre attempt to make those value judgments prevail that are favorable to them. To this extent, the phenomenon of morality is, from a biological standpoint, highly suspicious. Morality has developed hitherto at the expense of: the rulers and their specific instincts, the well-constituted and beautiful natures, those who are in any sense independent and privileged. Morality is therefore an opposition movement against the efforts of nature to achieve a higher type. Its effect is: mistrust of life in general (in so far as its tendencies are considered “immoral”)—hostility toward the senses (in so far as the supreme values are considered to be opposed to the supreme instincts)— degeneration and self-destruction of “higher natures,” because it is precisely in them that the conflict becomes conscious. 401 (March-June 1888) The Values That Have Been on Top Hitherto Morality as the supreme value, in all phases of philosophy (even among the skeptics). Result: this world is good for nothing, there must be a “real world.” What really determines the supreme value here? What is morality really? The instinct of decadence; it is the exhausted and

disinherited who in this way take their revenge and play the master— Historical proof: the philosophers always decadents, always in the service of the nihilistic religions. The instinct of decadence which appears as will to power. Introduction of its system of means: absolute immorality of means. General insight: supreme values hitherto are a special case of the will to power; morality itself is a special case of immorality. * Why the Opposing Values Always Succumbed How was this really possible? Question: why did life, physiological well-constitutedness everywhere succumb? Why was there no affirmative philosophy, no affirmative religion?— The historical signs of such movements: the pagan religion. Dionysus versus the “Crucified.” The Renaissance. Art. The strong and the weak: the healthy and the sick; the exception and the rule. There is no doubt who is the stronger— General aspect of history: Is man therefore an exception in the history of life?—Objection to Darwinism. The means the weak employ to keep themselves on top have become instincts, “humanity,” “institutions”— Proof of this dominion in our political instincts, in our social value judgments, in our arts, in our science. * The declining instincts have become master over the ascending instincts— The will to nothingness has become master over the will to life! —Is this true? is there perhaps not a stronger guarantee of life in this victory of the weak and mediocre?—is it perhaps only a means in the total movement of life, a slackening of tempo? a self-defense against something even worse? —Suppose the strong had become master in everything, and even in moral valuation: let us draw the consequences of how they would think about sickness, suffering, sacrifice! Self-contempt on the part of the weak would be the result; they would try to disappear and extinguish themselves. And would this be desirable?—and would we really want a world in which the influence of the weak, their subtlety, consideration, spirituality, pliancy was lacking?— * We have seen two “wills to power” in conflict (in this special case: we had a principle, that of considering right those who hitherto succumbed, and wrong those who hitherto prevailed): we have recognized the “real world” as a “false world” and morality as a form of immorality. We do not say: “The stronger is wrong.” We have grasped what it was that determined supreme value and why it became master over the opposing valuation—: it was stronger numerically. Now let us purify the opposite valuation of the infection and half-measures of the degeneration characteristic of the form in which it is known to us. Restoration of nature: moraline-free.

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Morality a useful error; more clearly in the case of the greatest and least prejudiced of its advocates, a lie that is considered necessary. 403 (1886-1887) One may admit the truth to oneself to the point where one is sufficiently elevated no longer to require the disciplinary school of [moral]116 error— When one judges existence morally, it disgusts. One should not invent unreal persons, e.g., one should not say “nature is cruel.” Precisely the insight that no such central responsible being exists is a relief! Evolution of man. a. To gain power over nature and in addition a certain power over oneself. (Morality was needed that man might prevail in his struggle with nature and the “wild animal.”) b. If power has been attained over nature, one can employ this power in the further free development of oneself: will to power as self-elevation and strengthening. 404 (1886-1887) Morality as an illusion of the species, designed to motivate the individual to sacrifice himself to the future: apparently allowing him an infinite value, so that by means of this self-consciousness he should tyrannize over and keep down other sides of his nature and find it hard to be content with himself. Profoundest gratitude for that which morality has achieved hitherto: but now it is only a burden which may become a fatality! Morality itself, in the form of honesty, compels us to deny morality. 405 (1885-1886) End To what an extent the self-destruction of morality is still a part of its own force. We Europeans have in us the blood of those who died for their faith; we have taken morality to be serious and awesome, and there is nothing that we have not in some way sacrificed to it. On the other hand: our spiritual subtlety has essentially been attained through conscience-vivisection. We do not yet know the “wither” toward which we are driven once we have detached ourselves from our old soil. But it was from this same soil that we acquired the force which now drives us forth into the distance, into adventures, thrusting us into the boundless, the untried, the undiscovered—we have no choice left, we have to be conquerors once we no longer have any country in which we are at home, in which we would want to “preserve” things. A concealed Yes drives us that is stronger than all our No’s. Our strength itself will no longer endure us in the old decaying soil: we venture away, we venture ourselves: the world is still rich and undiscovered, and even to perish is better than to become halfhearted and poisonous. Our strength itself drives us to sea, where all suns have hitherto gone down: we know of a new world— In the standard editions these words are omitted, obviously to avoid duplication of the section the German editors placed at the beginning of *The Will to Power*. Schlechta ignores 1911 (p 503) and reproduces the printed versions, not the text of the MS. Plainly, this is a draft Nietzsche rejected And it should be compared with *Twilight*, Chapter VII, section 5 (Portable Nietzsche, pp. 509-511), and, e g, section 142 above. Utilized in *Twilight*, Chapter I, section 36

(Portable Nietzsche, pp. 471-72). 79 “The starry heavens above me and the moral law within me.” 88 A member of the German Reich. 108 A section of the utmost importance for the understanding of Nietzsche’s opposition to Christianity and his contrast of Dionysus and Christ. In the first edition (1901) only the first paragraph was printed (as section 225). In the MS the second paragraph does not follow the first; it appears earlier in the same notebook, preceded by the words: “The same kind of man who wishes us ‘good weather’ also wishes only for ‘good men’ and, quite generally, for good qualities—at least the ever-growing dominion of what is good.” Schlechta ignores 1911, p. 504, and also p. 486, and reprints the text of the standard editions. See also section 881 below. 113 I doubt [it] For the contrast implicit in the last two sentences see also *The Gay Science*, Book V, section 344, which is discussed at length in my *Nietzsche*, Chapter 12, section III. III. CRITIQUE OF PHILOSOPHY 406 (1885-1886) Let us get rid of a few superstitions about philosophers that have been common so far! 407 (1884) Philosophers are prejudiced against appearance, change, pain, death, the corporeal, the senses, fate and bondage, the aimless. They believe first in: absolute knowledge, (2) in knowledge for the sake of knowledge, (3) in an association between virtue and happiness, (4) in the comprehensibility of human actions. [They are]118 led by instinctive moral definitions in which former cultural conditions are reflected (more dangerous ones). 408 (1884) What do philosophers lack? (a)119 an historical sense, (b) knowledge of physiology, (c) a goal in the future— The ability to formulate a critique without any irony or moral condemnation. 409 (1885) Philosophers (1) have had from the first a wonderful capacity for the *contradictio in adjecto*; (2) they have trusted in concepts as completely as they have mistrusted the senses: they have not stopped to consider that concepts and words are our inheritance from ages in which thinking was very modest and unclear. What dawns on philosophers last of all: they must no longer accept concepts as a gift, nor merely purify and polish them, but first make and create them, present them and make them convincing. Hitherto one has generally trusted one’s concepts as if they were a wonderful dowry from some sort of wonderland: but they are, after all, the inheritance from our most remote, most foolish as well as most intelligent ancestors. This piety toward what we find in us is perhaps part of the moral element in knowledge. What is needed above all is an absolute skepticism toward all inherited concepts (of the kind that one philosopher perhaps possessed—Plato, of course—for he taught the reverse). 410 (1885-1886) For the Preface Deeply mistrustful of the dogmas of epistemology, I loved to look now out of this window, now out of that; I guarded against settling down with any of these dogmas, considered them harmful—and finally: is it likely that a tool is able to criticize its own fitness?— What I noticed was rather that no epistemological skepticism or dogmatism had ever arisen free from ulterior motives—that it acquires a value of the second rank as soon as one has

considered what it was that compelled the adoption of this point of view. Fundamental insight: Kant as well as Hegel and Schopenhauer—the skeptical-epochistic attitude as well as the historicizing, as well as the pessimistic—have a moral origin. I saw no one who had ventured a critique of moral value feelings: and I soon turned my back on the meagre attempts made to arrive at a description of the origin of these feelings (as by the English and German Darwinists). How can Spinoza's position, his denial and rejection of moral value judgments, be explained? (It was one consequence of his theodicy!)

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Morality as supreme devaluation.— Either our world is the work and expression (modus) of God: in which case it must be supremely perfect (Leibniz's conclusion)—and one never doubted that one knew what constituted perfection—in which case evil must be only apparent (Spinoza is more radical, applying this to the concepts good and evil), or must proceed from God's supreme purpose (—perhaps as consequence of a particular mark of favor by God, who allows a choice between good and evil: the privilege of not being an automaton; “freedom” at the risk of making a mistake, of choosing wrongly—e.g., see Simplicius in his commentary on Epictetus). Or our world is imperfect, evil and guilt are actual and determined and absolutely inherent in its nature; in which case it cannot be the real world: in which case knowledge is only the way to a denial of it, for the world is an error which can be known to be an error. This is the opinion of Schopenhauer on the basis of Kantian presuppositions. Pascal is even more desperate: he comprehended that, in that case, even knowledge must be corrupt and falsified—that revelation was needed even to understand that the world ought to be denied. 412 (1883-1888) Because we are used to unconditional authorities we have come to need unconditional authorities:—this need is so strong that, even in a critical age such as Kant's, it showed itself superior to the need for criticism and was, in a certain sense, able to subject the entire work of critical reason and put it to its own uses.— It proved its superiority once again in the following generation, which was necessarily drawn by its historical instinct toward a relativity of all authority, by pressing into its service even the Hegelian philosophy of evolution, history re-baptized philosophy, and presenting history as the progressive self-revelation, self-surpassing of moral ideas. Since Plato, philosophy has been dominated by morality. Even in his predecessors, moral interpretations play a decisive role (with Anaximander, the perishing of all things as punishment for their emancipation from pure being; with Heraclitus, the regularity of phenomena as witness to the moral-legal character of the whole world of becoming). 413 (1885) Ulterior moral motives have hitherto most obstructed the course of philosophy. 414 (Jan.-Fall 1888)¹²¹ In all ages, one has taken “beautiful feelings” for arguments, the “heaving bosom” for the bellows of divinity, convictions for a “criterion of truth,” the need of an opponent for a question mark against wisdom: this falsehood, this counterfeiting, permeates the whole history of philosophy. The skeptics—respectable but rare—excepted, an instinct for intellectual integrity is nowhere evident. At last even Kant tried in all innocence to make this thinkers' corruption scientific by means of the concept “practical reason”: he invented a reason expressly for those cases in which one would not need to bother about reason: namely, when the needs of the heart, when morality, when “duty” speaks. 415 (1885-1886) Hegel: his popular side the

doctrine of war and great men. Right is with the victorious: they represent the progress of mankind. Attempt to prove the dominion of morality by means of history. Kant: a realm of moral values, withdrawn from us, invisible, real. Hegel: a demonstrable development, a becoming-visible of the moral realm. Let us not be deceived either in the Kantian or in the Hegelian manner:—we no longer believe in morality, as they did, and consequently we have no need to found a philosophy with the aim of justifying morality. Neither the critical nor the historicist philosophy has any charm for us in this respect:—so what charm has it, then?— 416 (1885-1886) The significance of German philosophy (Hegel): to evolve a pantheism through which evil, error, and suffering are not felt as arguments against divinity. This grandiose project has been misused by the existing powers (state, etc.), as if it sanctioned the rationality of whoever happened to be ruling. Schopenhauer, on the other hand, appears as a stubborn morality-man who, in order to justify his moral valuation, finally becomes a world-denier. Finally a “mystic.” I myself have attempted an aesthetic justification: how is the ugliness of the world possible?— I took the will to beauty, to persist in like forms, for a temporary means of preservation and recuperation: fundamentally, however, the eternally-creative appeared to me to be, as the eternal compulsion to destroy, associated with pain. The ugly is the form things assume when we view them with the will to implant a meaning, a new meaning, into what has become meaningless: the accumulated force which compels the creator to consider all that has been created hitherto as unacceptable, ill-constituted, worthy of being denied, ugly!— 417 (1883-1888) My first solution: Dionysian wisdom. Joy in the destruction of the most noble and at the sight of its progressive ruin: in reality joy in what is coming and lies in the future, which triumphs over existing things, however good. Dionysian: temporary identification with the principle of life (including the voluptuousness of the martyr). My innovations.— Further development of pessimism: intellectual pessimism; critique of morality, disintegration of the last consolation, Knowledge of the signs of decay: veils with illusion every firm action; culture isolates, is unjust and therefore strong. My endeavor to oppose decay and increasing weakness of personality. I sought a new center. Impossibility of this endeavor recognized. Thereupon I advanced further down the road of disintegration—where I found new sources of strength for individuals. We have to be destroyers!—I perceived that the state of disintegration, in which individual natures can perfect themselves as never before—is an image and isolated example of existence in general. To the paralyzing sense of general disintegration and incompleteness I opposed the eternal recurrence. 418 (1883-1888) One seeks a picture of the world in that philosophy in which we feel freest; i.e., in which our most powerful drive feels free to function. This will also be the case with me! 419 (1885) German philosophy as a whole—Leibniz, Kant,

Hegel, Schopenhauer, to name the greatest—is the most fundamental form of romanticism and homesickness there has ever been: the longing for the best that ever existed. One is no longer at home anywhere; at last one longs back for that place in which alone one can be at home, because it is the only place in which one would want to be at home: the Greek world! But it is in precisely that direction that all bridges are broken—except the rainbow-bridges of concepts! And these lead everywhere, into all the homes and “fatherlands” that existed for Greek souls! To be sure, one must be very subtle, very light, very thin to step across these bridges! But what happiness there is already in this will to spirituality, to ghostliness almost! How far it takes one from “pressure and stress,” from the mechanistic awkwardness of the natural sciences, from the market hubbub of “modern ideas”! One wants to go back, through the Church Fathers to the Greeks, from the north to the south, from the formulas to the Forms; one still relishes the exit from antiquity, Christianity, as an entrance to it, as in itself a goodly piece of the old world, as a glittering mosaic of ancient concepts and ancient value judgments. Arabesques, flourishes, rococo of scholastic abstractions—still better, that is to say subtler and thinner, than the peasant and mob reality of the European north, still a protest of higher spirituality against the peasants’ war and mob rebellion that has become master of spiritual taste in northern Europe and has found its leader in the great “unspiritual man,” Luther: in this respect, German philosophy is a piece of counter-Reformation, even of Renaissance, at least will to Renaissance, will to go on with the discovery of antiquity, the digging up of ancient philosophy, above all of the pre-Socratics—the most deeply buried of all Greek temples! A few centuries hence, perhaps, one will judge that all German philosophy derives its real dignity from being a gradual reclamation of the soil of antiquity, and that all claims to “originality” must sound petty and ludicrous in relation to that higher claim of the Germans to have joined anew the bond that seemed to be broken, the bond with the Greeks, the hitherto highest type of man. Today we are again getting close to all those fundamental forms of world interpretation devised by the Greek spirit through Anaximander, Heraclitus, Parmenides, Empedocles, Democritus, and Anaxagoras—we are growing more Greek by the day; at first, as is only fair, in concepts and evaluations, as Hellenizing ghosts, as it were: but one day, let us hope, also in our bodies! Herein lies (and has always lain) my hope for the German character! 420 (1884) I do not wish to persuade anyone to philosophy: it is inevitable, it is perhaps also desirable, that the philosopher should be a rare plant. I find nothing more repugnant than didactic praise of philosophy, as one finds it in Seneca, or worse, Cicero. Philosophy has little to do with virtue. Permit me to say that the scholar and scientist,¹²² too, are fundamentally different from the philosopher.—What I desire is that the genuine concept of the philosopher should not utterly perish in Germany. There are so

many halfhearted creatures of all kinds in Germany who would be glad to conceal their ill-constitutedness beneath so noble a name. 421 (1884) I have to set up the most difficult ideal of the philosopher. Learning is not enough! The scholar is the herd animal in the realm of knowledge—who inquires because he is ordered to and because others have done so before him.— 422 (1885) Superstition about philosophers: confusion with scholars and scientists. As if values were inherent in things and all one had to do was grasp them! To what extent they study under the direction of given values (their hatred of appearance, the body, etc.). Schopenhauer concerning morality (mockery of utilitarianism). At last, confusion goes so far that one regards Darwinism as philosophy: and now the scholars and scientists dominate. Even Frenchmen like Taine inquire, or think they inquire, without being already in possession of a standard of values. Prostration before “facts,” a kind of cult. In reality, they destroy the existing evaluations. Explanation of this misunderstanding. The man who can command rarely appears: he misinterprets himself. One positively wants to repudiate one’s own authority and assign it to circumstances.— In Germany, the esteem of the critic belongs to the history of awakening manhood. Lessing, etc. (Napoleon on Goethe). As a matter of fact, this movement was again reversed by German romanticism; and the fame of German philosophy depends on that, as if the danger of skepticism had thus been removed and faith could be proved. Both tendencies culminate in Hegel: at bottom, he generalized German criticism and German romanticism—a kind of dialectical fatalism, but in honor of the spirit, in fact with the submission of the philosopher to reality. The critic prepares the way: no more! With Schopenhauer the task of the philosopher dawns: the determination of value; still under the domination of eudaemonism. The ideal of pessimism.

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Theory and practice.¹²⁴—Fateful distinction, as if there were an actual drive for knowledge that, without regard to questions of usefulness and harm, went blindly for the truth; and then, separate from this, the whole world of practical interests — I tried to show, on the other hand, what instincts have been active behind all these pure theoreticians—how they have all, under the spell of their instincts, gone fatalistically for something that was “truth” for them—for them and only for them. The conflict between different systems, including that between epistemological scruples, is a conflict between quite definite instincts (forms of vitality, decline, classes, races, etc.). The so-called drive for knowledge can be traced back to a drive to appropriate and conquer: the senses, the memory, the instincts, etc. have developed as a consequence of this drive. The quickest possible reduction of the phenomena, economy, the accumulation of the spoils of knowledge (i.e., of world appropriated and made manageable)—Morality is such a curious science because it is in the highest degree practical: so that the position of pure knowledge, scientific integrity, is at once abandoned as soon as the claims of morality must be answered. Morality says: I need many answers—reasons, arguments; scruples can come afterward, or not at all—. “How should one act?”—If one considers that one is dealing with a sovereignly developed type that has “acted” for countless millennia, and in which everything has become instinct, expediency, automatism, fatality, then the urgency of this moral question must actually seem ridiculous. “How should one act?”—Morality has always been a misunderstanding: in reality, a species fated to act in this or that fashion wanted to justify itself, by dictating its norm as the universal norm—“How should one act?” is not a cause but an effect. Morality follows, the ideal comes at the end. —On the other hand, the appearance of moral scruples (in other words: the becoming-conscious of the values by which one acts) betrays a certain sickness; strong ages and peoples do not reflect on their rights, on the principles on which they act, on their instincts and reasons. Becoming-conscious is a sign that real morality, i.e., instinctive certainty in actions, is going to the devil—Every time a new world of consciousness is created, the moralists are a sign of damage, impoverishment, disorganization.—The deeply instinctive are shy of logicizing duties: among them are found Pyrrhonic opponents of dialectics and of knowability in general—A virtue is refuted with a “for”—Thesis: the appearance of moralists belongs to an age in which morality is coming to an end. Thesis: the moralist disintegrates the moral instincts, however much he may suppose himself to be their restorer. Thesis: that which really drives the moralist is not the moral instincts but the instincts of decadence translated into the formulas of morality—(he regards it as corruption when the instincts become uncertain). Thesis: the instincts of decadence, which, through the moralists, want

to become master over the instinctive morality of strong races and ages, are the instincts of the weak and underprivileged; the instincts of the exceptions, the solitaires, the abandoned, of the abortus in what is lofty and what is petty. the instincts of those habituated to suffering, who need a noble interpretation of their condition and therefore must know as little as possible about physiology. 424 (1885) The tartuffery of scientific manners.¹²⁶— One must not affect scientific manners where the time has not yet come to be scientific; but even the genuine investigator has to abandon the vanity of affecting a kind of method for which fundamentally the time has not yet come. Just as he must not “falsify” things and thoughts at which he has arrived in another way by imposing on them a false arrangement of deduction and dialectic. Thus Kant falsified in his “morality” his inner psychological tendency; a more recent example is Herbert Spencer’s ethics.— One should not conceal and corrupt the facts of how our thoughts have come to us. The profoundest and least exhausted books will probably always have something of the aphoristic and unexpected character of Pascal’s *Pensées*. The driving forces and evaluations have long lain below the surface; what comes out is effect. I fight all the tartuffery of false scientific manners: in the demonstration, if it does not correspond to the genesis of thoughts; in the claims to methods that are perhaps not yet possible at a certain stage of science; in the claims to objectivity, to cold impersonality, where, as in the case of all valuations, we describe ourselves and our inner experiences in a couple of words. There are ludicrous forms of vanity, e.g., that of Saint-Beuve, who worried all his life that he had now and then exhibited real warmth and passion either “for” or “against,” and would gladly have lied that fact out of his life.

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“Objectivity” in the philosopher: moral indifference toward oneself, blindness toward good or ill consequences: lack of scruples about using dangerous means; perversity and multiplicity of character considered and exploited as an advantage. My profound indifference toward myself: I desire no advantage from my insights and do not avoid the disadvantages that accompany them.— Here I include what might be called corruption of the character; this perspective is beside the point: I use my character, but try neither to understand nor to change it—the personal calculus of virtue has not entered my head for a moment. It seems to me that one shuts the door on knowledge as soon as one becomes interested in one’s own case—or, worse, the “salvation of one’s soul”!— One must not take one’s morality too seriously and not let oneself be deprived of a modest right to its opposite— A sort of inherited wealth of morality is perhaps presupposed here: one senses that one can squander a lot of it and throw it out the window without really impoverishing oneself. Never to feel tempted to admire “beautiful souls”; always to know oneself their superior. To encounter the monsters of virtue with an inward mockery; *déniaiser la vertu*—a secret pleasure. To revolve about oneself; no desire to become “better” or in any way “other.” Too interested not to throw the tentacles or nets of every morality out to things—.

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Toward a psychology of the psychologist. Psychologists as they are possible only beginning with the nineteenth century: no longer those loafers who look a mere three or four steps ahead and are almost content to burrow inside themselves. We psychologists of the future—we have little patience with introspection: we almost take it for a sign of degeneration when an instrument tries “to know itself”: we are instruments of knowledge and would like to possess all the naiveté and precision of an instrument—consequently, we must not analyze ourselves, “know” ourselves. First mark of the self-preservative instinct of the great psychologist: he never seeks himself, he has no eyes for himself, no interest or curiosity in himself— The great egoism of our dominating will requires that we shut our eyes to ourselves—that we must seem to be “impersonal,” “désintéressé” “objective”!—oh, how much we are the opposite of this! Just because we are to an eccentric degree psychologists. We are no Pascals, we are not especially interested in the “salvation of the soul,” in our own happiness, in our own virtue.— We have neither the time nor the curiosity to rotate about ourselves in that way. Considered more deeply, the case is different yet: we mistrust from the heart all navel gazing, because to us self-observation counts as a form of degeneration of the psychological genius, as a question mark against the instinct of the psychologist: just as surely as a painter’s eye is degenerate if it is governed by the will to see for the sake of seeing.

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The appearance of the Greek philosophers from Socrates onwards is a symptom of decadence; the anti-Hellenic instincts come to the top— The “Sophist” is still completely Hellenic—including Anaxagoras, Democritus, the great Ionians—but as a transitional form. The polis loses its faith in the uniqueness of its culture, in its right to rule over every other polis— One exchanges cultures, i.e., “the gods”—one thereby loses faith in the sole prerogative of the deus autochthonus. Good and evil of differing origin are mingled: the boundary between good and evil is blurred— This is the “Sophist”— The “philosopher,” on the other hand, is the reaction: he desires the old virtue. He sees the grounds of decay in the decay of institutions, he desires old institutions;—he sees the decay in the decay of authority: he seeks new authorities (travels abroad, into foreign literatures, into exotic religions—); he desires the ideal polis after the concept “polis” has had its day (approximately as the Jews held firm as a “people” after they had fallen into slavery). They are interested in all tyrants: they want to restore virtue by force majeure. Gradually everything genuinely Hellenic is made responsible for the state of decay (and Plato is just as ungrateful to Pericles, Homer, tragedy, rhetoric, as the prophets were to David and Saul). The decline of Greece is understood as an objection to the foundations of Hellenic culture: basic error of philosophers—. Conclusion: the Greek world perishes. Cause: Homer, myth, the ancient morality, etc. The anti-Hellenic development of the philosophers’ value judgment:—the Egyptian (“life after death” as a court of law—); the Semitic (the “dignity of the sage,” the “sheik”);—the Pythagoreans, the subterranean cults, silence, terrorization with a beyond, mathematics; the religious valuation, a kind of traffic with the cosmos;—the priestly, ascetic, transcendental;—dialectic—surely a repellent and pedantic concept splitting already in Plato?— Decline of good taste in spiritual matters: one is already insensitive to the ugliness and noisiness of all direct dialectics. Two decadence movements and extremes run side by side: (a) sensual, charmingly wicked decadence, loving art and show, and (b) gloomy religio-moral pathos, Stoic self-hardening, Platonic slander of the senses, preparation of the soil for Christianity.

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How far psychologists have been corrupted by the moral idiosyncrasy:—not one of the ancient philosophers had the courage for a theory of the “unfree will” (i.e., for a theory that denies morality);—no one had the courage to define the typical element in pleasure, every sort of pleasure (“happiness”) as the feeling of power: for to take pleasure in power was considered immoral;—no one had the courage to conceive virtue as a consequence of immorality (of a will to power) in the service of the species (or of the race or polis), for the will to power was considered immorality. In the entire evolution of morality, truth never appears: all the conceptual elements employed are fictions; all the psychologica accepted are falsifications; all the forms of logic dragged into this realm of lies are sophistries. What distinguishes moral philosophers themselves is a complete absence of cleanliness and intellectual self-discipline: they take “beautiful feelings” for arguments: they regard their “heaving bosom” as the bellows of divinity—Moral philosophy is the scabrous period in the history of the spirit. The first great example: in the name of morality, under the patronage of morality, an unheard-of wrong was perpetrated, in fact a piece of decadence in every respect. One cannot insist too strongly upon the fact that the great Greek philosophers represent the decadence of every kind of Greek excellence and make it contagious—“Virtue” made completely abstract was the greatest seduction to make oneself abstract: i.e., to detach oneself. It is a very remarkable moment: the Sophists verge upon the first critique of morality, the first insight into morality:—they juxtapose the multiplicity (the geographical relativity) of the moral value judgments;—they let it be known that every morality can be dialectically justified; i.e., they divine that all attempts to give reasons for morality are necessarily sophistical—a proposition later proved on the grand scale by the ancient philosophers, from Plato onwards (down to Kant);—they postulate the first truth that a “morality-in-itself,” a “good-in-itself” do not exist, that it is a swindle to talk of “truth” in this field. Where was intellectual integrity in those days? The Greek culture of the Sophists had developed out of all the Greek instincts; it belongs to the culture of the Periclean age as necessarily as Plato does not: it has its predecessors in Heraclitus, in Democritus, in the scientific types of the old philosophy; it finds expression in, e.g., the high culture of Thucydides. And—it has ultimately shown itself to be right: every advance in epistemological and moral knowledge has reinstated the Sophists—Our contemporary way of thinking is to a great extent Heraclitean, Democritean, and Protagorean: it suffices to say it is Protagorean, because Protagoras represented a synthesis of Heraclitus and Democritus. (Plato: a great Cagliostro—remember how Epicurus judged him,¹³¹ how Timon, the friend of Pyrrho, judged him—Is Plato’s integrity beyond

question?— But we know at least that he wanted to have taught as absolute truth what he himself did not regard as even conditionally true: namely, the separate existence and separate immortality of “souls.”)

429 (March-June 1888)

The Sophists are no more than realists: they formulate the values and practices common to everyone on the level of values—they possess the courage of all strong spirits to know their own immorality— Do you suppose perchance that these little Greek free cities, which from rage and envy would have liked to devour each other, were guided by philanthropic and righteous principles? Does one reproach Thucydides for the words he put into the mouths of the Athenian ambassadors when they negotiated with the Melians on the question of destruction or submission? Only complete Tartuffes could possibly have talked of virtue in the midst of this terrible tension—or men living apart, hermits, refugees, and emigrants from reality—people who negated in order to be able to live themselves— The Sophists were Greeks: when Socrates and Plato took up the cause of virtue and justice, they were Jews or I know not what— Grote's tactics in defense of the Sophists are false: he wants to raise them to the rank of men of honor and ensigns of morality—but it was their honor not to indulge in any swindle with big words and virtues—

430 (March-June 1888)

The great rationality of all education in morality has always been that one tried to attain to the certainty of an instinct: so that neither good intentions nor good means had to enter consciousness as such. As the soldier exercises, so should man learn to act. In fact, this unconsciousness belongs to any kind of perfection: even the mathematician employs his combinations unconsciously— What, then, is the significance of the reaction of Socrates, who recommended dialectics as the road to virtue and made mock when morality did not know how to justify itself logically?— As if this were not part of its value—without unconsciousness it is no good— Positing proofs as the presupposition for personal excellence in virtue signified nothing less than the disintegration of Greek instincts. They are themselves types of disintegration, all these great “virtuous men” and word-spinners. In praxi, this means that moral judgments are torn from their conditionality, in which they have grown and alone possess any meaning, from their Greek and Greek-political ground and soil, to be denaturalized under the pretense of sublimation. The great concepts “good” and “just” are severed from the presuppositions to which they belong and, as liberated “ideas,” become objects of dialectic. One looks for truth in them, one takes them for entities or signs of entities: one invents a world where they are at home, where they originate— In summa: the mischief has already reached its climax in Plato— And then one had need to invent the abstractly perfect man as well:—good, just, wise, a dialectician—in short, the scarecrow of the ancient philosopher: a plant removed from all soil; a humanity without any particular regulating instincts; a virtue that “proves” itself with reasons. The perfectly absurd “individuum” in itself! unnaturalness of the first water— In short, the consequence of the denaturalization of moral values was the creation of a degenerate type of man —“the good man,” “the happy man,” “the wise man.”— Socrates represents a moment of the profoundest perversity in the history of values. 431 (1885-1886 and 1888) Socrates.¹³²— This reversal of taste in favor of dialectics is a great question mark. What was it that really happened?— Socrates, the roturier who accomplished it, achieved by means of it victory over a more noble taste, the taste of the nobility:— the mob achieved victory with dialectics. Before Socrates, the dialectical manner was repudiated in good society; one believed it compromised one; youth was warned against it. Why this display of reasons? Why should one demonstrate? Against others one possessed authority. One commanded: that sufficed. Among one’s own, inter pares, one possessed tradition, also an authority: and, finally, one “understood one another”! One simply had no place for dialectic. Besides, one mistrusted such public presentation of one’s arguments. Honest things do not display their reasons in that way. There is something indecent about showing all one’s cards. What can

be “demonstrated” is of little worth.— The instinct of all party orators knows, moreover, that dialectics inspire mistrust, that they are very unconvincing. Nothing is easier to expunge than the effect of a dialectician. Dialectics can only be an emergency measure. One must experience an emergency, one must be obliged to extort one’s rights: otherwise one makes no use of dialectics. That is why the Jews were dialecticians, why Reynard the Fox was one, why Socrates was one. One has a merciless weapon in one’s hand. One can tyrannize with it. One compromises when one conquers. One leaves it to one’s victim to prove that he is not an idiot. One makes others furious and helpless, while one remains the embodiment of cool, triumphant reasonableness oneself—one deprives one’s opponent’s intelligence of potency.— The irony of the dialectician is a form of mob revenge: the ferocity of the oppressed finds an outlet in the cold knife-thrust of the syllogism— In Plato, as a man of overexcitable sensuality and enthusiasm, the charm of the concept had grown so strong that he involuntarily honored and deified the concept as an ideal Form. Intoxication by dialectic: as the consciousness of exercising mastery over oneself by means of it—as a tool of the will to power.

432134 (March-June 1888)

The problem of Socrates.— The two antitheses: the tragic disposition, the Socratic disposition—measured according to the law of life. To what extent the Socratic disposition is a phenomenon of decadence: to what extent, however, a robust health and strength is still exhibited in the whole habitus, in the dialectics, efficiency, and self-discipline of the scientific man (—the health of the plebeian; his wickedness, esprit frondeur,¹³⁵ his cunning, his canaille au fond are held in check by shrewdness; “ugly”). Making ugly: self-mockery, dialectical dryness, shrewdness as tyrant in opposition to a “tyrant” (instinct). Everything is exaggerated, eccentric, caricature, in Socrates, a buffo with the instincts of Voltaire. He discover a new form of agon;¹³⁷ he is the first fencing master to the leading circles of Athens; he represents nothing but the highest form of shrewdness: he calls it “virtue” (—he divined it to be deliverance: he was not shrewd from choice, it was de rigueur); to have oneself under control, so as to go into battle with reasons and not with affects (—the cunning of Spinoza—the unravelling of the errors caused by affects);—to discover that one can capture anyone in whom one produces affects, to discover that affects proceed illogically; practice in self-mockery, so as to damage the feeling of rancor at its roots. I try to understand from what partial and idiosyncratic states the Socratic problem derives: his equalization of reason = virtue = happiness. It was with this absurdity of a doctrine of identity that he fascinated: the philosophers of antiquity never again freed themselves from this fascination— Absolute lack of objective interest: hatred for science; the idiosyncrasy of feeling oneself as a problem. Socrates’ acoustic hallucination: morbid element. When the spirit is rich and independent it most resists any preoccupation with morality. How came it that Socrates was a monomaniac in regard to morality?— In emergencies, “practical” philosophy steps at once to the fore. Morality and religion as chief interests are signs of an emergency.

433139 (March-June 1888)

—Shrewdness, clarity, severity and logicity as weapons against the ferocity of the drives. These must be dangerous and threaten destruction: otherwise there would be no sense in developing shrewdness to the point of making it into a tyrant. To make a tyrant of shrewdness:—but for that the drives must be tyrants. This is the problem.— In those days it was a very timely problem. Reason became = virtue = happiness. Solution: The Greek philosophers rest on the same fundamental facts of inner experience as Socrates: five steps from excess, from anarchy, from intemperance—all men of decadence. They need him as a physician: logic as will to power, to self-mastery, to “happiness.” The ferocity and anarchy of the instincts in the case of Socrates is a symptom of decadence. The superfetation of logic and of clarity of reason included. Both are abnormalities, both belong together. Critique. Decadence betrays itself in this preoccupation with “happiness” (i.e., with “salvation of the soul,” i.e., to feel one’s condition as a danger). The fanaticism of its interest in “happiness” indicates the pathological nature of the hidden cause: it was a life-or-death interest. To be reasonable or perish was the alternative before which they all stood. The moralism of the Greek philosophers indicates that they felt themselves to be in danger—

434 (March-June 1888)

Why everything resolved itself into play-acting.— The rudimentary psychology that considered only the conscious motives of men (as causes), that took “consciousness” for an attribute of the soul, that sought a will (i.e., an intention) behind all action: it needed, first, only to answer “Happiness” to the question: What do men want? (one dared not say “Power”: that would have been immoral); —consequently there is in all the actions of men the intention of attaining happiness. Secondly: if man does in fact not achieve happiness, why is it? Because he blunders in respect of the means.— What is unfaillingly the means to happiness? Answer: virtue.— Why virtue?— Because it is supremely rational and because rationality makes it impossible to err in the choice of means: it is as reason that virtue is the way to happiness. Dialectic is the constant occupation of virtue, because it excludes all clouding of the intellect and all affects. In fact, man does not want “happiness.” Pleasure is a feeling of power: if one excludes the affects, then one excludes the states that give the highest feeling of power, consequently of pleasure. The highest rationality is a cold, clear state very far from giving that feeling of happiness that intoxication of any kind brings with it — The philosophers of antiquity combat everything that intoxicates—that impairs the absolute coldness and neutrality of the consciousness— They were consistent with their false presupposition: that consciousness is the exalted, the supreme state, the precondition of perfection—whereas the opposite is true—— To the extent that it is willed, to the extent that it is conscious, there is no perfection in action of any kind. The philosophers of antiquity were the greatest duffers in practice because they condemned themselves to be duffers in theory— In praxi, everything resolved itself into play-acting;—and whoever saw through this, e.g., Pyrrho, judged as everyone did, namely that in goodness and integrity “little people” were far superior to philosophers. All the more profound natures of antiquity were disgusted with the philosophers of virtue: they were looked upon as quarrelsome and play actors. (Judgment on Plato: that of Epicurus,¹⁴⁰ that of Pyrrho). Result: little people are superior to them in their way of living, in patience, in goodness and mutual assistance:—approximately the claim made by Dostoevsky or Tolstoy for his muzhiks: they are more philosophical in practice, they meet the exigencies of life more courageously—

435 (March-June 1888)

Toward a critique of the philosopher.— It is a self-deception of philosophers and moralists to imagine that they escape decadence by opposing it. That is beyond their will; and, however little they acknowledge it, one later discovers that they were among the most powerful promoters of decadence. [Let us take]¹⁴¹ the philosophers of Greece, e.g., Plato. He severed the instincts from the polis, from contest, from military efficiency, from art and beauty, from the mysteries, from belief in tradition and ancestors— He was the seducer of the nobility: he was himself seduced by the roturier Socrates— He negated all the presuppositions of the “noble Greek” of the old stamp, made dialectic an everyday practice, conspired with tyrants, pursued politics of the future and provided the example of the most complete severance of the instincts from the past. He is profound, passionate in everything anti-Hellenic— These great philosophers represent one after the other the typical forms of decadence: the moral-religious idiosyncrasy, anarchism, nihilism (adiaphora),¹⁴² cynicism, obduracy, hedonism, reaction. The question of “happiness,” of “virtue,” of “salvation of the soul” is the expression of physiological contradictoriness in these types of decline: their instincts lack a center of gravity, a purpose. 436 (1885-1886) To what extent dialectic and faith in reason still rest on moral prejudices. With Plato we are, as former inhabitants of an intelligible world of the good, still in possession of a heritage from that time: divine dialectic, as proceeding from the good, leads to all things good (—therefore, as it were, “backwards” —). Even Descartes had a notion of the fact that in a fundamentally Christian-moral mode of thought, which believes in a good God as the creator of things, only God’s veracity guarantees to us the judgments of our senses. Apart from a religious sanction and guarantee of our senses and rationality—where should we derive a right to trust in existence! That thinking is a measure of actuality—that what cannot be thought, is not—is a rude non plus ultra of a moralistic trustfulness (in an essential truth-principle at the bottom of things), in itself a mad assumption, which experience contradicts every moment. We are altogether unable to think anything at all just as it is—

437 (March-June 1888)

The real philosophers of Greece are those before Socrates (—with Socrates something changes). They are all noble persons, setting themselves apart from people and state,¹⁴⁴ traveled, serious to the point of somberness, with a slow glance, no strangers to state affairs and diplomacy. They anticipate all the great conceptions of things: they themselves represent these conceptions, they bring themselves into a system. Nothing gives a higher idea of the Greek spirit than this sudden fruitfulness in types, than this involuntary completeness in the erection of the great possibilities of the philosophical ideal.— I seen only one original figure in those that came after: a late arrival but necessarily the last—the nihilist Pyrrho:—his instinct was opposed to all that had come to the top in the meantime: the Socratics, Plato, the artist's optimism of Heraclitus. (Pyrrho goes back, through Protagoras, to Democritus—). * Sagacious weariness: Pyrrho. To live a lowly life among the lowly. No pride. To live in the common way; to honor and believe what all believe. On guard against science and spirit, also against all that inflates— Simple: indescribably patient, carefree, mild. Apatheia,¹⁴⁶ or rather *praôtes*.¹⁴⁷ A Buddhist for Greece, grown up amid the tumult of the schools; a latecomer; weary; the protest of weariness against the zeal of the dialecticians; the unbelief of weariness in the importance of all things. He had seen Alexander, he had seen the Indian penitents. To such refined latecomers, everything lowly, everything poor, even everything idiotic is seductive. It has a narcotic effect: it relaxes (Pascal). On the other hand, in the midst of the crowd and confounded with everyone else, they feel a little warmth: these weary people need warmth— To overcome contradiction; no contest; no will to distinction; to deny the Greek instincts. (Pyrrho lived with his sister who was a midwife.) To disguise wisdom so that it no longer distinguishes; to cloak it in poverty and rags; to perform the lowliest offices: to go to market and sell suckling pigs— Sweetness; light; indifference; no virtues that require gestures: to be everyone's equal even in virtue: ultimate self-overcoming, ultimate indifference. Pyrrho, like Epicurus, two forms of Greek decadence: related, in hatred for dialectics and for all theatrical virtues—these two together were in those days called philosophy—; deliberately holding in low esteem that which they loved; choosing common, even despised names for it; representing a state in which one is neither sick nor well, neither alive nor dead— Epicurus more naive, idyllic, grateful; Pyrrho more traveled, experienced, nihilistic— His life was a protest against the great doctrine of identity (happiness = virtue = knowledge). One cannot promote the right way of life through science: wisdom does not make “wise”— The right way of life does not want happiness, turns away from happiness—

438 (Spring 1888)

The struggle against the “old faith” as undertaken by Epicurus was, in a strict sense, a struggle against pre-existing Christianity— a struggle against the old world grown senile and sick, already gloomy, moralized, soured by feelings of guilt. Not the “moral corruption” of antiquity, but precisely its moralization is the prerequisite through which alone Christianity could become master of it. Moral fanaticism (in short: Plato) destroyed paganism, by revaluing its values and poisoning its innocence.— We ought finally to understand that what was then destroyed was higher than what became master!— Christianity has grown out of psychological decay, could only take root in decayed soil.

439 (March-June 1888)

Scientific manners: as training or as instinct.—In the Greek philosophers I see a decline of the instincts: otherwise they could not have blundered so far as to posit the conscious state as more valuable. Intensity of consciousness stands in inverse ratio to ease and speed of cerebral transmission. Among Greek philosophers the reverse opinion about instinct prevailed: which is always a sign of weakened instincts. We must in fact seek perfect life where it has become least conscious (i.e., least aware of its logic, its reasons, its means and intentions, its utility). The return to the facts of *bon sens*, of the *bon homme*, of the “little people” of all kinds. The stored-up integrity and shrewdness of generations which are never conscious of their principles and are even a little afraid of principles. The demand for a virtue that reasons is not reasonable— A philosopher is compromised by such a demand.

440 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

When morality—that is to say subtlety, caution, bravery, equity—has been as it were stored up through the practice of a whole succession of generations, then the total force of this accumulated virtue radiates even into that sphere where integrity is most seldom found, into the spiritual sphere. In all becoming-conscious there is expressed a discomfiture of the organism; it has to try something new, nothing is sufficiently adapted for it, there is toil, tension, strain—all this constitutes becoming-conscious—Genius resides in instinct; goodness likewise. One acts perfectly only when one acts instinctively. Even from the viewpoint of morality, all conscious thinking is merely tentative, usually the reverse of morality. Scientific integrity is always ruptured when the thinker begins to reason: try the experiment of putting the wisest men on the most delicate scales by making them talk about morality—“When enough subtlety, bravery, caution, and moderation have been collected through the practice of a long chain of generations, then the instinctive power of such incorporated virtue radiates even into the most spiritual matters—and that phenomenon becomes visible which we call intellectual integrity. This is very rare: among philosophers it is lacking “One can take the scientific manner or, morally speaking the intellectual integrity of a thinker, the subtlety, bravery, caution, and moderation that have become instinct in him and transposed even into the most spiritual matters, and place them on the most delicate scales—by letting him talk about morality: then the most famous philosophers show that their scientific manner is as yet only a conscious affair, a beginning, a ‘good will,’ something laborious—and as soon as their instincts begin to speak, as soon as they moralize, it is all over with the discipline and subtlety of their conscience “The scientific manner—whether mere training and external or the final result of long discipline and moral practice: in the former case it abdicates as soon as the instincts speak (e.g., the religious instincts or those of the concept of duty); in the latter case it replaces these instincts and no longer grants them admission, feeling they represent uncleanness and seductions—” Although omitted in most editions, this version is printed in an appendix in both the Grossoktav edition and the Musarion edition, as #1074. Schlechta omits it. It is included here not only as a matter of principle but also for three additional reasons: (1) it is interesting to see how the editors of the various editions proceeded; (2) it is even more interesting to be able to compare two alternative drafts from Nietzsche’s hand; and (3) parts of this draft compare very favorably with the one included in the text. It could be proved that all conscious thinking would also show a far lower standard of morality than the thinking of the same man when it is directed by his instincts.

441 (March-June 1888)

The struggle against Socrates, Plato, all the Socratic schools, proceeds from the profound instinct that one does not make men better when one represents to them that virtue is demonstrable and asks for reasons— Ultimately, it is the measly fact that the agonal instinct in all these born dialecticians compelled them to glorify their personal ability as the highest quality and to represent all other good things as conditioned by it. The anti-scientific spirit of this entire “philosophy”: it is determined to be in the right.

442 (March-June 1888)

This is extraordinary. We find from the beginning of Greek philosophy onwards a struggle against science with the means of an epistemology or skepticism: and with what object? Always for the good of morality— (Hatred for physicists and physicians.) Socrates, Aristippus, the Megarian school, the Cynics, Epicurus, Pyrrho—a general assault on knowledge for the good of morality— (Hatred for dialectics also.) A problem remains: they approach the Sophists in order to get rid of science. On the other hand, the physicists are all so completely subjected as to take up the schema of truth,¹⁴⁹ of real being, into the fundamentals of their science; e.g., the atom, the four elements (juxtaposition of beings to explain multiplicity and change—). Contempt for objective interest is taught: return to the practical interest, the personal utility of all knowledge— The struggle against science is directed against (1) its pathos (objectivity), (2) its means (i.e., against its utility), (3) its results (as childish). It is the same struggle that is later conducted by the church in the name of piety: the church inherited the entire arsenal of antiquity for its struggle. Epistemology played in this the same role as it did in the case of Kant, in the case of the Indians— One does not want to be troubled by it: one wants one's hands free for one's "course." What were they really defending themselves against? Against Obligation, against legality, against the compulsion to go hand in hand— I believe one calls this freedom— Decadence manifests itself in this: the instinct of solidarity is so degenerate that solidarity is felt as tyranny: they want no authority, no solidarity, no lining up with the rank and file to adopt its ignobly slack pace. They hate the measured step, the tempo of science, they hate the lack of urgency, the perseverance, the indifference to himself of the man of science.

443 (March-June 1888)

Fundamentally, morality is hostile to science: Socrates was so already—and for this reason, that science takes things seriously that have nothing to do with “good” and “evil,” consequently makes the feeling for “good” and “evil” seem less important. For morality demands that the whole man and all his forces should stand in its service: it considers it a squandering on the part of one not rich enough to squander when man concerns himself seriously with plants and stars. This is why scientific procedures rapidly declined in Greece once Socrates had introduced into science the disease of moralizing; the height attained in the disposition of a Democritus, Hippocrates, and Thucydides was not attained a second time.

444 (March-June 1888)

Problem of the philosopher and the man of science.— Influence of age; depressive habits (staying-at-home à la Kant; overwork; insufficient nourishment of the brain; reading). More essentially: whether a tendency toward generalities is not already a symptom of decadence; objectivity as disintegration of the will (—to be able to stand so distant—) This presupposes a great adiaphora in regard to the powerful drives: a kind of isolation, exceptional stance, resistance in regard to the normal drives. Type: desertion of the homeland; further and further afield; increasing exoticism; the old imperatives become dumb—; certainly this continual questioning “whither?” (“happiness”) is a sign of disengagement from forms of organization, of a breaking loose. Problem: whether the man of science is more of a symptom of decadence than the philosophers:—he is not disengaged as a whole, only a part of him is absolutely dedicated to knowledge, trained to one corner and perspective—he needs all the virtues of a strong race and health, great severity, manliness, shrewdness. He is a symptom more of a higher multiplicity of culture than of its weariness. The scholar of decadence is a bad scholar. While the philosopher of decadence has counted, hitherto at least, as the typical philosopher.

445 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Nothing is rarer among philosophers than intellectual integrity: perhaps they say the opposite, perhaps they even believe it. But a condition of their entire occupation is that only certain truths are admitted; they know that which they have to prove; that they are at one over these “truths” is virtually their means of recognizing one another as philosophers. There are, e.g., moral truths. But a faith in morals is not a proof of morality: there are cases—and the case of the philosopher is one—in which such a faith is simply a piece of immorality.

446 (March-June 1888)

What, then, is regressive in the philosopher?— That he teaches that his qualities are the necessary and sole qualities for the attainment of the “highest good” (e.g., dialectic, as with Plato). That he orders men of all kinds gradatim up to his type as the highest. That he despises what is generally esteemed—that he opens up a gulf between priestly values and worldly values. That he knows what is true, what God is, what the goal is, what the way is— The typical philosopher is here an absolute dogmatist;—if he has need of skepticism, it is so as to be able to speak dogmatically about his main interest.

447 (March-June 1888)

The philosopher in opposition to his rivals; e g, in opposition to science: then he becomes a skeptic; then he reserves to himself a form of knowledge that he denies the man of science; then he goes hand in hand with the priest so as not to arouse the suspicion of atheism, materialism; he regards an attack on himself as an attack on morality, virtue, religion, order—he knows how to discredit his opponents as “seducers” and “underminers” : then he goes hand in hand with power. The philosopher in a struggle with other philosophers—he tries to compel them to appear as anarchists, unbelievers, opponents of authority. In summa: in so far as he struggles, he struggles just as a priest does, just as priesthood does. 448 (Manuscript source uncertain)¹⁵² Philosophy defined by Kant as “the science of the limitations of reason”!!

449 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Philosophy as the art of discovering truth: according to Aristotle. Contradicted by the Epicureans, who made use of Aristotle's sensualistic theory of knowledge: they rejected the search for truth with irony; "Philosophy as an art of living"

450 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The three great naiveties: Knowledge as a means to happiness (as if—), as a means to virtue (as if—), as a means to “denial of life”—to the extent that it is a means to disappointment—(as if—) 451 (Manuscript source uncertain)¹⁵³ That there should be a “truth” which one could somehow approach—!

452 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Error and ignorance are fateful.— The view that truth is found and that ignorance and error are at an end is one of the most potent seductions there is. Supposing it is believed, then the will to examination, investigation, caution, experiment is paralyzed: it can even count as criminal, namely as doubt concerning truth— “Truth” is therefore more fateful than error and ignorance, because it cuts off the forces that work toward enlightenment and knowledge. The affect of laziness now takes the side of “truth”— (“thinking is distress, misery!”); as do order, rule, happiness in possessing, pride in wisdom—vanity in summa:—it is more comfortable to obey than to examine; it is more flattering to think “I possess the truth” than to see only darkness around one—above all: it is reassuring, it gives confidence, it alleviates life—it “improves” the character, to the extent that it lessens mistrust. “Peace of soul,” “a quiet conscience”: all inventions made possible only by presupposing that truth has been found.— “By their fruits shall ye know them”— “Truth” is truth, for it makes men better— The process goes on: everything good, all success, is placed to the credit of “truth.” This is the proof of strength:¹⁵⁴ the happiness, the contentment, the well-being of the community, as of the individual, are henceforth understood as the consequence of belief in morality— The converse: ill success is attributed to lack of faith—.

453 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The causes of error lie just as much in the good will [as in the ill will] of man—: in a thousand cases he conceals reality from himself, he falsifies it, so as not to suffer from his good [or ill] will. E.g., God as the director of human destiny: or the interpretation of his own petty destiny as if everything were contrived and sent with a view to the salvation of his soul—this lack of “philology,” which to a more subtle intellect would have to count as uncleanness and counterfeiting, is, on the average, performed under the inspiration of good will. Good will, “noble feelings,” “lofty states” are in the means they employ just as much counterfeiters and deceivers as the affects repudiated by morality and called egoistic: love, hate, revenge. Errors are what mankind has had to pay for most dearly: and, on the whole, it is the errors of “good will” which have harmed it most profoundly. The illusion that makes happy is more pernicious than that which has immediate bad consequences: the latter sharpens and purifies reason and makes it more mistrustful—the former lulls it to sleep.— Beautiful feelings, sublime agitations, are, physiologically speaking, among the narcotics: their misuse has precisely the same consequences as the misuse of any other opiate—neurasthenia— 454 (1888) Error is the most expensive luxury that man can permit himself; and if the error happens to be a physiological error, then it is perilous to life. What, consequently, has man hitherto paid for most dearly? For his “truths”: for they have all been errors in physiologicis—

455 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Psychological confusions:—the demand for belief—confused with the “will to truth” (e.g., in the case of Carlyle).¹⁵⁸ But in the same way, the demand for unbelief has been confused with the “will to truth” (—the need to get free from a belief, for a hundred reasons: to be in the right against some “believers”). What inspires the skeptic? Hatred of the dogmatist—or a need for rest, a weariness, as in the case of Pyrrho. The advantages that one anticipated from truth were advantages resulting from belief in it:—in itself, that is, truth could be altogether painful, harmful, fateful—. One likewise disputed the “truth” only when one promised oneself advantages from one’s victory—e.g., freedom from the ruling powers. The methods of truth were not invented from motives of truth, but from motives of power, of wanting to be superior. How is truth proved? By the feeling of enhanced power—by utility—by indispensability—in short, by advantages (namely, presuppositions concerning what truth ought to be like for us to recognize it). But that is a prejudice: a sign that truth is not involved at all— What, e.g., is the meaning of the “will to truth” in the case of the Goncourts?¹⁶⁰ in the case of the naturalists?— Critique of “objectivity.” Why know: why not rather be deceived?— What one always wanted was faith—and not truth— Faith is created by means antithetical to the methods of research—: they even exclude the latter—.

456 (March-June 1888)

A Certain degree of faith serves us today as an objection to what is believed—
even more as a question mark against the spiritual health of the believer.

457 (Jan-Fall 1888)

Martyrs.— In order to combat anything founded on reverence, the attacker must be possessed of a somewhat audacious, relentless, even shameless disposition— Now if one considers that mankind has for millennia sanctified as truths only what was error, that is has even branded any critique of these as a sign of a wicked disposition, then one is bound to confess with regret that a goodly amount of immorality was needed to provide the initiative for aggression, in other words for reason— These immoralists should be forgiven for always having posed as “martyrs to truth”: the truth is that it was not the drive to truth which made them negate, but disintegration, sacrilegious skepticism, pleasure in adventure—. In other cases, it is personal rancor that drives them into the domain of problems—they combat problems in order to be in the right against particular people. But it is revenge above all that science has been able to employ— the revenge of the oppressed, those who had been pushed aside and, in fact, oppressed by the prevailing truth— Truth, that is to say, the scientific method, was grasped and promoted by those who divined in it a weapon of war—an instrument of destruction— To make their opposition honorable, they needed, moreover, an apparatus similar in kind to that used by those they were attacking: —they adopted the concept “truth” just as ostentatiously and unconditionally as their opponents— they became fanatics, at least they posed as such, because no other pose was taken seriously. What remained to be done was accomplished by persecution, passion and the insecurity of the persecuted—hatred grew and consequently the precondition for remaining scientific was diminished. Ultimately, they all wanted to be right in the same absurd fashion as their opponents— The words “conviction,” “faith,” the pride of martyrdom—these are the least favorable states for the advancement of knowledge. The opponents of truth at last reaccepted the entire subjective manner of deciding questions of truth, namely by poses, sacrifices, heroic resolutions—and thus prolonged the dominion of antiscientific methods. As martyrs they compromised their own deed. 458 (March-June 1888)161 Dangerous distinction between “theoretical” and “practical,” e.g., in the case of Kant, but also in the case of the ancients:— they act as if pure spirituality presented them with the problems of knowledge and metaphysics;—they act as if practice must be judged by its own measure, whatever the answer of theory may be. Against the former I direct my psychology of philosophers: their most alienated calculations and their “spirituality” are still only the last pallid impression of a physiological fact; the voluntary is absolutely lacking, everything is instinct, everything has been directed along certain lines from the beginning— Against the latter I ask whether we know of any other method of acting well than always thinking well; the latter is an action, and the former presupposes thought. Have we a different method for

judging the value of a way of life from judging the value of a theory: by induction, by comparison?— The naive believe that we are better equipped here, that here we know what is “good”—philosophers repeat it. We conclude that a faith is here at work, nothing more— “One must act; consequently rules of conduct are needed”— said even the skeptics of antiquity. The urgent need for a decision as an argument for considering something true! “One must not act”— said their more consistent brothers, the Buddhists, and conceived a rule of conduct to liberate one from actions— To accommodate oneself, to live as the “common man” lives, to hold right and good what he holds right: this is to submit to the herd instinct One must take one’s courage and severity so far as to feel such a submission as a disgrace. Not to live with two different standards!— Not to separate theory and practice!—

459 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

That nothing formerly held true is true— What was formerly despised as unholy, forbidden, contemptible, fateful—all these flowers grow today along the lovely paths of truth. This entire old morality concerns us no more: there is not a concept in it that still deserves respect. We have outlived it— we are no longer coarse and naive enough to have to let ourselves be deceived in this fashion— In more polite words: we are too virtuous for it— And if truth in the old sense was “truth” only because the old morality affirmed it, had a right to affirm it, then it follows that we no longer have need of any former truths, either— Our criterion of truth is by no means morality: we refute an opinion by showing it to be dependent on morality, to be inspired by noble feelings.

460 (March-June 1888)

All these values are empirical and conditional. But he who believes in them, who reverences them, refuses to recognize just this characteristic of them.

Philosophers believe one and all in these values, and one form their reverence took was the attempt to make a priori truths of them. The falsifying character of reverence— Reverence is the supreme test of integrity: but in the entire history of philosophy there is no intellectual integrity—but only “love of the good”—

The absolute lack of methods of testing the value of these values; secondly: reluctance to test values, to take them as being in any way conditional.— In the case of moral values, all the antiscientific instincts came together with the object of excluding science—

461 (March-June 1888)

Why philosophers are slanderers.— The treacherous and blind hostility of philosophers towards the senses—how much of mob and middle class there is in this hatred! The common people always consider an abuse of which they feel the ill consequences as an objection to that which is abused: all insurrectionary movements aimed against principles, whether political or economic, argue thus, with the idea of representing an abuse as being necessary to, and inherent in, the principle. It is a miserable story: man seeks a principle through which he can despise men—he invents a world so as to be able to slander and bespatter this world: in reality, he reaches every time for nothingness and construes nothingness as “God,” as “truth,” and in any case as judge and condemner of this state of being— If one wants a proof of how profoundly and thoroughly the actually barbarous needs of man seek satisfaction, even when he is tamed and “civilized,” one should take a look at the “leitmotifs” of the entire evolution of philosophy:—a sort of revenge on reality, a malicious destruction of the valuations by which men live, an unsatisfied soul that feels the tamed state as a torture and finds a voluptuous pleasure in a morbid unraveling of all the bonds that tie it to such a state. This section, including the passage just cited, was utilized by Nietzsche in *Twilight*, Chapters III and IV. The history of philosophy is a secret raging against the preconditions of life, against the value feelings of life, against partisanship in favor of life. Philosophers have never hesitated to affirm a world provided it contradicted this world and furnished them with a pretext for speaking ill of this world. It has been hitherto the grand school of slander; and it has imposed itself to such an extent that today our science, which proclaims itself the advocate of life, has accepted the basic slanderous position and treated this world as apparent, this chain of causes as merely phenomenal. What is it really that hates here? I fear it is still the Circe of philosophers, morality, that has here bewitched them into having to be slanderers forever— They believed in moral “truths,” they found there the supreme values— what else could they do but deny existence more firmly the more they got to know it? — For this existence is immoral— And this life depends upon immoral preconditions: and all morality denies life—. Let us abolish the real world: and to be able to do this we first have to abolish the supreme value hitherto, morality— It suffices to demonstrate that even morality is immoral, in the sense in which immorality has always been condemned. If the tyranny of former values is broken in this way, if we have abolished the “real world,” then a new order of values must follow of its own accord. The apparent world and the world invented by a lie—this is the antithesis. The latter has hitherto been called the “real world,” “truth,” “God.” This is what we have to abolish. Logic of my conception: Morality as supreme value (master over all phases of philosophy, even over the

skeptics). Result: this world is good for nothing, it is not the “real world.” What here determines the supreme value? What is morality, really?— The instinct of decadence; it is the exhausted and disinherited who take revenge in this fashion. Historical proof: philosophers are always decadents—in the service of the nihilistic religions. The instinct of decadence which appears as will to power. Proof: the absolute immorality of means throughout the entire history of morality. General insight: the highest values hitherto are a special case of the will to power; morality itself is a special case of immorality.¹⁶³

462 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Fundamental innovations: In place of “moral values,” purely naturalistic values. Naturalization of morality. In place of “sociology,” a theory of the forms of domination. In place of “society,” the culture complex, as my chief interest (as a whole or in its parts). In place of “epistemology,” a perspective theory of affects (to which belongs a hierarchy of the affects; the affects transfigured; their superior order, their “spirituality”). In place of “metaphysics” and religion, the theory of eternal recurrence (this as a means of breeding and selection). 463 (1885) My precursors: Schopenhauer; to what extent I deepened pessimism and by devising its extremest antithesis first really experienced it. Then: the ideal artists, that after-product of the Napoleonic movement. Then: the higher Europeans, predecessors of great politics. Then: the Greeks and their origins. 164 464 (1885) I have named those who were unknowingly my workers and precursors. But where may I look with any kind of hope for my kind of philosopher himself, at the least for my need of new philosophers? 165 In that direction alone where a noble mode of thought is dominant, such as believes in slavery and in many degrees of bondage as the precondition of every higher culture; where a creative mode of thought dominates that does not posit the happiness of repose, the “Sabbath of Sabbaths” as a goal for the world, and honors even in peace the means to new wars; 166 a mode of thought that prescribes laws for the future, that for the sake of the future is harsh and tyrannical towards itself and all things of the present; a reckless, “immoral” mode of thought, which wants to develop both the good and the bad qualities in man to their fullest extent, because it feels it has the strength to put both in their right place—in the place where each needs the other. But he who thus looks for philosophers today, what prospect has he of finding what he is looking for? Is it not likely that, even with the best Diogenes lantern, he will search about in vain all day and all night? The age possesses the reverse instincts; it wants, first and above all, comfort; it wants, in the second place, publicity and that great actors’ hubbub, that great drum banging that appeals to its unfair tastes; it wants, thirdly, that everyone should fall on his face in the profoundest subjection before the greatest of all lies—it is called “equality of men”—and honor exclusively those virtues that level and equalize. But the rise of the philosopher, as I understand him, is therewith rendered altogether impossible, notwithstanding that it is thought in all innocence to be favorable to him. Indeed, all the world bewails today the evil situation of the philosopher in earlier times, hemmed in between the stake, bad conscience, and the arrogant wisdom of the Church Fathers: the truth, however, is that precisely this was a much more favorable condition for the education of a powerful, comprehensive, cunning and audaciously daring spirituality than the conditions of life at present. Today,

another kind of spirit, namely the spirit of the demagogue, the spirit of the actor, perhaps also the scholarly beaver- and ant-like spirit, finds conditions favorable. But things are so much the worse even for superior artists: for are they not, almost all of them, perishing from a lack of inner discipline? They are no longer tyrannized over from without by a church's tables of absolute values or those of a court; thus they also no longer learn to develop their "inner tyrants," their will. And what is true of artists is true in a higher and more fateful sense of philosophers. For where are there free spirits today? Show me a free spirit today!

465 (Summer-Fall 1888)

I understand by “freedom of spirit” something quite definite: being a hundred times superior to philosophers and other disciples of “truth” in severity towards oneself, in cleanliness and courage, in the unconditional will to say No where it is dangerous to say No—I treat previous philosophers as contemptible libertines hiding in the cloak of the woman “truth.” 122 “Scholar and scientist”: der wissenschaftliche Mensch. 129 “Of decay”: uncertain reading; MS illegible. I.
THE WILL TO POWER AS KNOWLEDGE

466 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

It is not the victory of science that distinguishes our nineteenth century, but the victory of scientific method over science.

467 (Spring-Fall 1887)

History of scientific method, considered by Auguste Comte as virtually philosophy itself.

468 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The great methodologists: Aristotle, Bacon, Descartes, Auguste Comte.

469 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The most valuable insights are arrived at last; but the most valuable insights are methods. All the methods, all the presuppositions of our contemporary science were for millennia regarded with the profoundest contempt; on their account one was excluded from the society of respectable people—one was considered as an “enemy of God,” as a reviler of the highest ideal, as “possessed.” We have had the whole pathos of mankind against us—our conception of what “truth” should be, what service of truth should be, our objectivity, our method, our silent, cautious, mistrustful ways were considered perfectly contemptible—At bottom, it has been an aesthetic taste that has hindered mankind most it believed in the picturesque effect of truth, it demanded of the man of knowledge that he should produce a powerful effect on the imagination. This looks as if an antithesis has been achieved, a leap made; in reality, the schooling through moral hyperbole prepared the way step by step for that milder of pathos that became incarnate in the scientific character—The conscientiousness in small things, the self-control of the religious man were a preparatory school for the scientific character: above all, the disposition that takes problems seriously, regardless of the personal consequences—470 (1885-1886) Profound aversion to reposing once and for all in any one total view of the world. Fascination of the opposing point of view: refusal to be deprived of the stimulus of the enigmatic. 471 (1885-1886) The presupposition that things are, at bottom, ordered so morally that human reason must be justified—is an ingenuous presupposition and a piece of naiveté, the after-effect of belief in God’s veracity—God understood as the creator of things.—These concepts an inheritance from a former existence in a beyond——472 (1883-1888) Contradiction of the alleged “facts of consciousness.” Observation is a thousand times more difficult, error perhaps a condition of observation in general. 473 (1886-1887) The intellect cannot criticize itself, simply because it cannot be compared with other species of intellect and because its capacity to know would be revealed only in the presence of “true reality,” i.e., because in order to criticize the intellect we should have to be a higher being with “absolute knowledge.” This presupposes that, distinct from every perspective kind of outlook or sensual-spiritual appropriation, something exists, an “in-itself.”—But the psychological derivation of the belief in things forbids us to speak of “things-in-themselves.”

474 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

That a sort of adequate relationship subsists between subject and object, that the object is something that if seen from within would be a subject, is a well-meant invention which, I think, has had its day. The measure of that of which we are in any way conscious is totally dependent upon the coarse utility of its becoming-conscious: how could this nook-perspective of consciousness permit us to assert anything of “subject” and “object” that touched reality!— 475 (1885-1886)

Critique of modern philosophy: erroneous starting point, as if there existed “facts of consciousness”—and no phenomenalism in introspection. 476 (1884)

“Consciousness”—to what extent the idea of an idea, the idea of will, the idea of a feeling (known to ourselves alone) are totally superficial! Our inner world, too, “appearance”!

477 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

I maintain the phenomenality of the inner world, too: everything of which we become conscious is arranged, simplified, schematized, interpreted through and through—the actual process of inner “perception,” the causal connection between thoughts, feelings, desires, between subject and object, are absolutely hidden from us—and are perhaps purely imaginary. The “apparent inner world” is governed by just the same forms and procedures as the “outer” world. We never encounter “facts”: pleasure and displeasure are subsequent and derivative intellectual phenomena— “Causality” eludes us; to suppose a direct causal link between thoughts, as logic does—that is the consequence of the crudest and clumsiest observation. Between two thoughts all kinds of affects play their game: but their motions are too fast, therefore we fail to recognize them, we deny them — “Thinking,” as epistemologists conceive it, simply does not occur: it is a quite arbitrary fiction, arrived at by selecting one element from the process and eliminating all the rest, an artificial arrangement for the purpose of intelligibility — The “spirit,” something that thinks: where possible even “absolute, pure spirit”—this conception is a second derivative of that false introspection which believes in “thinking”: first an act is imagined which simply does not occur, “thinking,” and secondly a subject-substratum in which every act of thinking, and nothing else, has its origin: that is to say, both the deed and the doer are fictions.

478 (March-June 1888)

One must not look for phenomenalism in the wrong place: nothing is more phenomenal (or, more clearly:) nothing is so much deception as this inner world which we observe with the famous “inner sense.” We have believed in the will as cause to such an extent that we have from our personal experience introduced a cause into events in general (i.e., intention a cause of events—). We believe that thoughts as they succeed one another in our minds stand in some kind of causal relation: the logician especially, who actually speaks of nothing but instances which never occur in reality, has grown accustomed to the prejudice that thoughts cause thoughts—. We believe—and even our philosophers still believe—that pleasure and pain are causes of reactions, that the purpose of pleasure and pain is to occasion reactions. For millennia, pleasure and the avoidance of displeasure have been flatly asserted as the motives for every action. Upon reflection, however, we should concede that everything would have taken the same course, according to exactly the same sequence of causes and effects, if these states “pleasure and displeasure” had been absent, and that one is simply deceiving oneself if one thinks they cause anything at all: they are epiphenomena with a quite different object than to evoke reactions; they are themselves effects within the instituted process of reaction. In summa. everything of which we become conscious is a terminal phenomenon, an end—and causes nothing; every successive phenomenon in consciousness is completely atomistic— And we have sought to understand the world through the reverse conception—as if nothing were real and effective but thinking, feeling, willing!—

479 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The phenomenism of the “inner world.” Chronological inversion, so that the cause enters consciousness later than the effect.— We have learned that pain is projected to a part of the body without being situated there—we have learned that sense impressions naively supposed to be conditioned by the outer world are, on the contrary, conditioned by the inner world; that we are always unconscious of the real activity of the outer world— The fragment of outer world of which we are conscious is born after an effect from outside has impressed itself upon us, and is subsequently projected as its “cause”— In the phenomenism of the “inner world” we invert the chronological order of cause and effect. The fundamental fact of “inner experience” is that the cause is imagined after the effect has taken place— The same applies to the succession of thoughts:—we seek the reason for a thought before we are conscious of it; and the reason enters consciousness first, and then its consequence— Our entire dream life is the interpretation of complex feelings with a view to possible causes—and in such way that we are conscious of a condition only when the supposed causal chain associated with it has entered consciousness. The whole of “inner experience” rests upon the fact that a cause for an excitement of the nerve centers is sought and imagined—and that only a cause thus discovered enters consciousness: this cause in no way corresponds to the real cause—it is a groping on the basis of previous “inner experiences,” i.e., of memory. But memory also maintains the habit of the old interpretations, i.e., of erroneous causality—so that the “inner experience” has to contain within it the consequences of all previous false causal fictions. Our “outer world” as we project it every moment is indissolubly tied to the old error of the ground: we interpret it by means of the schematism of “things,” etc. “Inner experience” enters our consciousness only after it has found a language the individual understands—i.e., a translation of a condition into conditions familiar to him—; “to understand” means merely: to be able to express something new in the language of something old and familiar. E.g., “I feel unwell”—such a judgment presupposes a great and late neutrality of the observer—; the simple man always says: this or that makes me feel unwell—he makes up his mind about his feeling unwell only when he has seen a reason for feeling unwell.— I call that a lack of philology; to be able to read off a text as a text without interposing an interpretation is the last-developed form of “inner experience”— perhaps one that is hardly possible—

480 (March-June 1888)

There exists neither “spirit,” nor reason, nor thinking, nor consciousness, nor soul, nor will, nor truth: all are fictions that are of no use. There is no question of “subject and object,” but of a particular species of animal that can prosper only through a certain relative rightness; above all, regularity of its perceptions (so that it can accumulate experience)— Knowledge works as a tool of power. Hence it is plain that it increases with every increase of power— The meaning of “knowledge”: here, as in the case of “good” or “beautiful,” the concept is to be regarded in a strict and narrow anthropocentric and biological sense. In order for a particular species to maintain itself and increase its power, its conception of reality must comprehend enough of the calculable and constant for it to base a scheme of behavior on it. The utility of preservation—not some abstract-theoretical need not to be deceived—stands as the motive behind the development of the organs of knowledge—they develop in such a way that their observations suffice for our preservation. In other words: the measure of the desire for knowledge depends upon the measure to which the will to power grows in a species: a species grasps a certain amount of reality in order to become master of it, in order to press it into service. 481 (1883-1888) Against positivism, which halts at phenomena—“There are only facts”—I would say: No, facts is precisely what there is not, only interpretations. We cannot establish any fact “in itself”: perhaps it is folly to want to do such a thing. “Everything is subjective,” you say; but even this is interpretation. The “subject” is not something given, it is something added and invented and projected behind what there is.— Finally, is it necessary to posit an interpreter behind the interpretation? Even this is invention, hypothesis. In so far as the word “knowledge” has any meaning, the world is knowable; but it is interpretable otherwise, it has no meaning behind it, but countless meanings.— “Perspectivism.” It is our needs that interpret the world; our drives and their For and Against. Every drive is a kind of lust to rule; each one has its perspective that it would like to compel all the other drives to accept as a norm. 482 (1886-1887) We set up a word at the point at which our ignorance begins, at which we can see no further, e.g., the word “I,” the word “do,” the word “suffer”:—these are perhaps the horizon of our knowledge, but not “truths.” 483 (1885) Through thought the ego is posited; but hitherto one believed as ordinary people do, that in “I think” there was something of immediate certainty, and that this “I” was the given cause of thought, from which by analogy we understood all other causal relationships. However habitual and indispensable this fiction may have become by now—that in itself proves nothing against its imaginary origin: a belief can be a condition of life and nonetheless be false.²

484 (Spring-Fall 1887)

“There is thinking: therefore there is something that thinks”: this is the upshot of all Descartes’ argumentation. But that means positing as “true a priori” our belief in the concept of substance— that when there is thought there has to be something “that thinks” is simply a formulation of our grammatical custom that adds a doer to every deed. In short, this is not merely the substantiation of a fact but a logical-metaphysical postulate— Along the lines followed by Descartes one does not come upon something absolutely certain but only upon the fact of a very strong belief. If one reduces the proposition to “There is thinking, therefore there are thoughts,” one has produced a mere tautology: and precisely that which is in question, the “reality of thought,” is not touched upon—that is, in this form the “apparent reality” of thought cannot be denied. But what Descartes desired was that thought should have, not an apparent reality, but a reality in itself.

485 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The concept of substance is a consequence of the concept of the subject: not the reverse! If we relinquish the soul, “the subject,” the precondition for “substance” in general disappears. One acquires degrees of being, one loses that which has being. Critique of “reality”: where does the “more or less real,” the gradation of being in which we believe, lead to?— The degree to which we feel life and power (logic and coherence of experience) gives us our measure of “being,” “reality,” not-appearance. The subject: this is the term for our belief in a unity underlying all the different impulses of the highest feeling of reality: we understand this belief as the effect of one cause—we believe so firmly in our belief that for its sake we imagine “truth,” “reality,” “substantiality” in general. — “The subject” is the fiction that many similar states in us are the effect of one substratum: but it is we who first created the “similarity” of these states; our adjusting them and making them similar is the fact, not their similarity (—which ought rather to be denied—). 486 (1885-1886) One would have to know what being is, in order to decide whether this or that is real (e.g., “the facts of consciousness”); in the same way, what certainty is, what knowledge is, and the like.— But since we do not know this, a critique of the faculty of knowledge is senseless: how should a tool be able to criticize itself when it can use only itself for the critique? It cannot even define itself! 3 487 (1883-1886) Must all philosophy not ultimately bring to light the preconditions upon which the process of reason depends?—our belief in the “ego” as a substance, as the sole reality from which we ascribe reality to things in general? The oldest “realism” at last comes to light: at the same time that the entire religious history of mankind is recognized as the history of the soul superstition. Here we come to a limit: our thinking itself involves this belief (with its distinction of substance, accident; deed, doer, etc.); to let it go means: being no longer able to think. But that a belief, however necessary it may be for the preservation of a species, has nothing to do with truth, one knows from the fact that, e.g., we have to believe in time, space, and motion, without feeling compelled to grant them absolute reality.

488 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Psychological derivation of our belief in reason.— The concept “reality,” “being,” is taken from our feeling of the “subject.” “The subject”: interpreted from within ourselves, so that the ego counts as a substance, as the cause of all deeds, as a doer. The logical-metaphysical postulates, the belief in substance, accident, attribute, etc., derive their convincing force from our habit of regarding all our deeds as consequences of our will—so that the ego, as substance, does not vanish in the multiplicity of change.— But there is no such thing as will.— We have no categories at all that permit us to distinguish a “world in itself” from a “world of appearance.” All our categories of reason are of sensual origin: derived from the empirical world. “The soul,” “the ego”—the history of these concepts shows that here, too, the oldest distinction (“breath,” “life”)— If there is nothing material, there is also nothing immaterial. The concept no longer contains anything. No subject “atoms.” The sphere of a subject constantly growing or decreasing, the center of the system constantly shifting; in cases where it cannot organize the appropriate mass, it breaks into two parts. On the other hand, it can transform a weaker subject into its functionary without destroying it, and to a certain degree form a new unity with it. No “substance,” rather something that in itself strives after greater strength, and that wants to “preserve” itself only indirectly (it wants to surpass itself—). 489 (1886-1887) Everything that enters consciousness as “unity” is already tremendously complex: we always have only a semblance of unity. The phenomenon of the body is the richer, clearer, more tangible phenomenon: to be discussed first, methodologically, without coming to any decision about its ultimate significance. 490 (1885) The assumption of one single subject is perhaps unnecessary; perhaps it is just as permissible to assume a multiplicity of subjects, whose interaction and struggle is the basis of our thought and our consciousness in general? A kind of aristocracy of “cells” in which dominion resides? To be sure, an aristocracy of equals, used to ruling jointly and understanding how to command? My hypotheses: The subject as multiplicity. Pain intellectual and dependent upon the judgment “harmful”: projected. The effect always “unconscious”: the inferred and imagined cause is projected, follows in time. Pleasure is a kind of pain. The only force that exists is of the same kind as that of the will: a commanding of other subjects, which thereupon change. The continual transitoriness and fleetingness of the subject. “Mortal soul.” Number as perspective form. 491 (1885-1886) Belief in the body is more fundamental than belief in the soul: the latter arose from unscientific reflection on [the agonies of] the body (something that leaves it. Belief in the truth of dreams—). 492 (1885) The body and physiology the starting point: why? — We gain the correct idea of the nature of our subject-unity, namely as regents at the head of a communality (not as “souls” or “life forces”), also of the

dependence of these regents upon the ruled and of an order of rank and division of labor as the conditions that make possible the whole and its parts. In the same way, how living unities continually arise and die and how the “subject” is not eternal; in the same way, that the struggle expresses itself in obeying and commanding, and that a fluctuating assessment of the limits of power is part of life. The relative ignorance in which the regent is kept concerning individual activities and even disturbances within the communality is among the conditions under which rule can be exercised. In short, we also gain a valuation of not-knowing, of seeing things on a broad scale, of simplification and falsification, of perspectivity. The most important thing, however, is: that we understand that the ruler and his subjects are of the same kind, all feeling, willing, thinking—and that, wherever we see or divine movement in a body, we learn to conclude that there is a subjective, invisible life appertaining to it. Movement is symbolism for the eye; it indicates that something has been felt, willed, thought. The danger of the direct questioning of the subject about the subject and of all self-reflection of the spirit lies in this, that it could be useful and important for one’s activity to interpret oneself falsely. That is why we question the body and reject the evidence of the sharpened senses: we try, if you like, to see whether the inferior parts themselves cannot enter into communication with us. 493 (1885) Truth is the kind of error without which a certain species of life could not live. The value for life is ultimately decisive.⁵ 494 (1885) It is improbable that our “knowledge” should extend further than is strictly necessary for the preservation of life. Morphology shows us how the senses and the nerves, as well as the brain, develop in proportion to the difficulty of finding nourishment. Likewise our love of the beautiful: it also is our shaping will. The two senses stand side-by-side; the sense for the real is the means of acquiring the power to shape things according to our wish. The joy in shaping and reshaping—a primeval joy! We can comprehend only a world that we ourselves have made. 496 (1884) Of the multifariousness of knowledge. To trace one’s own relationship to many other things (or the relationship of kind)—how should that be “knowledge” of other things! The way of knowing and of knowledge is itself already part of the conditions of existence: so that the conclusion that there could be no other kind of intellect (for us) than that which preserves us is precipitate: this actual condition of existence is perhaps only accidental and perhaps in no way necessary. Our apparatus for acquiring knowledge is not designed for “knowledge.” 497 (1884) The most strongly believed a priori “truths” are for me—provisional assumptions; e.g., the law of causality, a very well acquired habit of belief, so much a part of us that not to believe in it would destroy the race. But are they for that reason truths? What a conclusion! As if the preservation of man were a proof of truth! 498 (1884) To what extent even our intellect is a consequence of conditions of existence—: we would not have it if we did not

need to have it, and we would not have it as it is if we did not need to have it as it is, if we could live otherwise. 499 (1885) "Thinking" in primitive conditions (pre-organic) is the crystallization of forms, as in the case of crystal.— In our thought, the essential feature is fitting new material into old schemas (= Procrustes' bed), making equal what is new. 500 (1885-1886) Sense perceptions projected "outside": "inside" and "outside"—does the body command here—? The same equalizing and ordering force that rules in the idioplasma, rules also in the incorporation of the outer world: our sense perceptions are already the result of this assimilation and equalization in regard to all the past in us; they do not follow directly upon the "impression"— 501 (1886-1887) All thought, judgment, perception, considered as comparison, has as its precondition a "positing of equality," and earlier still a "making equal." The process of making equal is the same as the process of incorporation of appropriated material in the amoeba. "Memory" late, in so far as here the drive to make equal seems already to have been subdued: differentiation is preserved. Remembering as a process of classification and pigeonholing: who is active? 502 (1885) One must revise one's ideas about memory: here lies the chief temptation to assume a "soul," which, outside time, reproduces, recognizes, etc. But that which is experienced lives on "in the memory"; I cannot help it if it "comes back," the will is inactive in this case, as in the coming of any thought. Something happens of which I become conscious: now something similar comes—who called it? roused it? 503 (1884) The entire apparatus of knowledge is an apparatus for abstraction and simplification—directed not at knowledge but at taking possession of things: "end" and "means" are as remote from its essential nature as are "concepts." With "end" and "means" one takes possession of the process (one invents a process that can be grasped); with "concepts," however, of the "things" that constitute the process. 504 (1883-1888) Consciousness—beginning quite externally, as coordination and becoming conscious of "impressions"—at first at the furthest distance from the biological center of the individual; but a process that deepens and intensifies itself, and continually draws nearer to that center. 505 (1885-1886) Our perceptions, as we understand them: i.e., the sum of all those perceptions the becoming-conscious of which was useful and essential to us and to the entire organic process—therefore not all perceptions in general (e.g., not the electric); this means: we have senses for only a selection of perceptions—those with which we have to concern ourselves in order to preserve ourselves. Consciousness is present only to the extent that consciousness is useful. It cannot be doubted that all sense perceptions are permeated with value judgments (useful and harmful—consequently, pleasant or unpleasant). Each individual color is also for us an expression of value (although we seldom admit it, or do so only after a protracted impression of exclusively the same color; e.g., a prisoner in prison, or a lunatic). Thus insects also react differently to different

colors: some like [this color, some that];⁷ e.g., ants. 506 (1884) First images—to explain how images arise in the spirit. Then words, applied to images. Finally concepts, possible only when there are words—the collecting together of many images in something nonvisible but audible (word). The tiny amount of emotion to which the “word” gives rise, as we contemplate similar images for which one word exists—this weak emotion is the common element, the basis of the concept. That weak sensations are regarded as alike, sensed as being the same, is the fundamental fact. Thus confusion of two sensations that are close neighbors, as we take note of these sensations; but who is taking note? Believing is the primal beginning even in every sense impression: a kind of affirmation the first intellectual activity! A “holding-true” in the beginning! Therefore it is to be explained: how “holding-true” arose! What sensation lies behind “true”?

507 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The valuation “I believe that this and that is so” as the essence of “truth.” In valuations are expressed conditions of preservation and growth. All our organs of knowledge and our senses are developed only with regard to conditions of preservation and growth. Trust in reason and its categories, in dialectic, therefore the valuation of logic, proves only their usefulness for life, proved by experience—not that something is true. That a great deal of belief must be present; that judgments may be ventured; that doubt concerning all essential values is lacking—that is the precondition of every living thing and its life. Therefore, what is needed is that something must be held to be true—not that something is true. “The real and the apparent world”—I have traced this antithesis back to value relations. We have projected the conditions of our preservation as predicates of being in general. Because we have to be stable in our beliefs if we are to prosper, we have made the “real” world a world not of change and becoming, but one of being. 508 (1883-1888) Originally a chaos of ideas. The ideas that were consistent with one another remained, the greater number perished—and are perishing. 509 (1883-1888) The earthly kingdom of desires out of which logic grew: the herd instinct in the background. The assumption of similar cases presupposes “similar souls.” For the purpose of mutual agreement and dominion. 510 (1883-1888) On the origin of logic. The fundamental inclination to posit as equal, to see things as equal, is modified, held in check, by consideration of usefulness and harmfulness, by considerations of success: it adapts itself to a milder degree in which it can be satisfied without at the same time denying and endangering life. This whole process corresponds exactly to that external, mechanical process (which is its symbol) by which protoplasm makes what it appropriates equal to itself and fits it into its own forms and files. 511 (1885-1886) Equality and similarity. The coarser organ sees much apparent equality; the spirit wants equality, i.e., to subsume a sense impression into an existing series: in the same way as the body assimilates inorganic matter. Toward an understanding of logic: the will to equality is the will to power—the belief that something is thus and thus (the essence of judgment) is the consequence of a will that as much as possible shall be equal. 512 (1885) Logic is bound to the condition: assume there are identical cases. In fact, to make possible logical thinking and inferences, this condition must first be treated fictitiously as fulfilled. That is: the will to logical truth can be carried through only after a fundamental falsification of all events is assumed. From which it follows that a drive rules here that is capable of employing both means, firstly falsification, then the implementation of its own point of view: logic does not spring from will to truth.

513 (Fall 1886)

The inventive force that invented categories labored in the service of our needs, namely of our need for security, for quick understanding on the basis of signs and sounds, for means of abbreviation:—"substance," "subject," "object," "being," "becoming" have nothing to do with metaphysical truths.— It is the powerful who made the names of things into law, and among the powerful it is the greatest artists in abstraction who created the categories.

514 (March-June 1888)

A morality, a mode of living tried and proved by long experience and testing, at length enters consciousness as a law, as dominating— And therewith the entire group of related values and states enters into it: it becomes venerable, unassailable, holy, true; it is part of its development that its origin should be forgotten— That is a sign it has become master— Exactly the same thing could have happened with the categories of reason: they could have prevailed, after much groping and fumbling, through their relative utility— There came a point when one collected them together, raised them to consciousness as a whole—and when one commanded them, i.e., when they had the effect of a command— From then on, they counted as a priori, as beyond experience, as irrefutable. And yet perhaps they represent nothing more than the expediency of a certain race and species—their utility alone is their “truth”—

515 (March-June 1888)

Not “to know” but to schematize—to impose upon chaos as much regularity and form as our practical needs require. In the formation of reason, logic, the categories, it was need that was authoritative: the need, not to “know,” but to subsume, to schematize, for the purpose of intelligibility and calculation— (The development of reason is adjustment, invention, with the aim of making similar, equal—the same process that every sense impression goes through!) No pre-existing “idea” was here at work, but the utilitarian fact that only when we see things coarsely and made equal do they become calculable and usable to us— Finality in reason is an effect, not a cause: life miscarries with any other kinds of reason, to which there is a continual impulse—it becomes difficult to survey— too unequal— The categories are “truths’ ” only in the sense that they are conditions of life for us: as Euclidean space is a conditional “truth.” (Between ourselves: since no one would maintain that there is any necessity for men to exist, reason, as well as Euclidean space, is a mere idiosyncrasy of a certain species of animal, and one among many—) The subjective compulsion not to contradict here is a biological compulsion: the instinct for the utility of inferring as we do infer is part of us, we almost are this instinct— But what naïveté to extract from this a proof that we are therewith in possession of a “truth in itself”! — Not being able to contradict is proof of an incapacity, not of “truth.”

516 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

We are unable to affirm and to deny one and the same thing: this is a subjective empirical law, not the expression of any “necessity” but only of an inability. If, according to Aristotle, the law of contradiction is the most certain of all principles, if it is the ultimate and most basic, upon which every demonstrative proof rests, if the principle of every axiom lies in it; then one should consider all the more rigorously what presuppositions already lie at the bottom of it. Either it asserts something about actuality, about being, as if one already knew this from another source; that is, as if opposite attributes could not be ascribed to it. Or the proposition means: opposite attributes should not be ascribed to it. In that case, logic would be an imperative, not to know the true, but to posit and arrange a world that shall be called true by us. In short, the question remains open: are the axioms of logic adequate to reality or are they a means and measure for us to create reality, the concept “reality,” for ourselves?—To affirm the former one would, as already said, have to have a previous knowledge of being—which is certainly not the case. The proposition therefore contains no criterion of truth, but an imperative concerning that which should count as true. Supposing there were no self-identical “A”, such as is presupposed by every proposition of logic (and of mathematics), and the “A” were already mere appearance, then logic would have a merely apparent world as its condition. In fact, we believe in this proposition under the influence of ceaseless experience which seems continually to confirm it. The “thing”—that is the real substratum of “A”; our belief in things is the precondition of our belief in logic. The “A” of logic is, like the atom, a reconstruction of the thing—If we do not grasp this, but make of logic a criterion of true being, we are on the way to positing as realities all those hypostases: substance, attribute, object, subject, action, etc.; that is, to conceiving a metaphysical world, that is, a “real world” (—this, however, is the apparent world once more—). The very first acts of thought, affirmation and denial, holding true and holding not true, are, in as much as they presuppose, not only the habit of holdings things true and holding them not true, but a right to do this, already dominated by the belief that we can gain possession of knowledge, that judgments really can hit upon the truth;—in short, logic does not doubt its ability to assert something about the true-in-itself (namely, that it cannot have opposite attributes). Here reigns the coarse sensualistic prejudice that sensations teach us truths about things—that I cannot say at the same time of one and the same thing that it is hard and that it is soft. (The instinctive proof “I cannot have two opposite sensations at the same time”—quite coarse and false.) The conceptual ban on contradiction proceeds from the belief that we are able to form concepts, that the concept not only designates the essence of a thing but comprehends it—In fact, logic (like geometry and arithmetic) applies only to fictitious entities that

we have created. Logic is the attempt to comprehend the actual world by means of a scheme of being posited by ourselves; more correctly, to make it formulatable and calculable for us—

517 (Spring-Fall 1887)

In order to think and infer it is necessary to assume beings: logic handles only formulas for what remains the same. That is why this assumption would not be proof of reality: “beings” are part of our perspective. The “ego” as a being (—not affected by becoming and development). The fictitious world of subject, substance, “reason,” etc., is needed—: there is in us a power to order, simplify, falsify, artificially distinguish. “Truth” is the will to be master over the multiplicity of sensations:—to classify phenomena into definite categories. In this we start from a belief in the “in-itself” of things (we take phenomena as real). The character of the world in a state of becoming as incapable of formulation, as “false,” as “self-contradictory.” Knowledge and becoming exclude one another. Consequently, “knowledge” must be something else: there must first of all be a will to make knowable, a kind of becoming must itself create the deception of beings. 518 (1885-1886) If our “ego” is for us the sole being, after the model of which we fashion and understand all being: very well! Then there would be very much room to doubt whether what we have here is not a perspective illusion—an apparent unity that encloses everything like a horizon. The evidence of the body reveals a tremendous multiplicity; it is allowable, for purposes of method, to employ the more easily studied, richer phenomena as evidence for the understanding of the poorer. Finally: supposing everything is becoming, then knowledge is possible only on the basis of belief in being. 519 (1883-1888) If there “is only one being, the ego” and all other “being” is fashioned after its model—if, finally, belief in the “ego” stands or falls with belief in logic, i.e., the metaphysical truth of the categories of reason; if, on the other hand, the ego proves to be something in a state of becoming: then— 520 (1885) Continual transition forbids us to speak of “individuals,” etc; the “number” of beings is itself in flux. We would know nothing of time and motion if we did not, in a coarse fashion, believe we see what is at “rest” beside what is in motion. The same applies to cause and effect, and without the erroneous conception of “empty space” we should certainly not have acquired the conception of space. The principle of identity has behind it the “apparent fact” of things that are the same. A world in a state of becoming could not, in a strict sense, be “comprehended” or “known”; only to the extent that the “comprehending” and “knowing” intellect encounters a coarse, already-created world, fabricated out of mere appearances but become firm to the extent that this kind of appearance has preserved life—only to this extent is there anything like “knowledge”; i.e., a measuring of earlier and later errors by one another.

521 (Spring-Fall 1887)

On “logical semblance”—The concepts “individual” and “species” equally false and merely apparent. “Species” expresses only the fact that an abundance of similar creatures appear at the same time and that the tempo of their further growth and change is for a long time slowed down, so actual small continuations and increases are not very much noticed (—a phase of evolution in which the evolution is not visible, so an equilibrium seems to have been attained, making possible the false notion that a goal has been attained—and that evolution has a goal—). The form counts as something enduring and therefore more valuable; but the form has merely been invented by us; and however often “the same form is attained,” it does not mean that it is the same form—what appears is always something new, and it is only we, who are always comparing, who include the new, to the extent that it is similar to the old, in the unity of the “form.” As if a type should be attained and, as it were, was intended by and inherent in the process of formation. Form, species, law, idea, purpose—in all these cases the same error is made of giving a false reality to a fiction, as if events were in some way obedient to something—an artificial distinction is made in respect of events between that which acts and that toward which the act is directed (but this “which” and this “toward” are only posited in obedience to our metaphysical-logical dogmatism: they are not “facts”). One should not understand this compulsion to construct concepts, species, forms, purposes, laws (“a world of identical cases”) as if they enabled us to fix the real world; but as a compulsion to arrange a world for ourselves in which our existence is made possible:—we thereby create a world which is calculable, simplified, comprehensible, etc., for us. This same compulsion exists in the sense activities that support reason—by simplification, coarsening, emphasizing, and elaborating, upon which all “recognition,” all ability to make oneself intelligible rests. Our needs have made our senses so precise that the “same apparent world” always reappears and has thus acquired the semblance of reality. Our subjective compulsion to believe in logic only reveals that, long before logic itself entered our consciousness, we did nothing but introduce its postulates into events: now we discover them in events—we can no longer do otherwise—and imagine that this compulsion guarantees something connected with “truth.” It is we who created the “thing,” the “identical thing,” subject, attribute, activity, object, substance, form, after we had long pursued the process of making identical, coarse and simple. The world seems logical to us because we have made it logical. 522 (1886-1887) Ultimate solution.—We believe in reason: this, however, is the philosophy of gray concepts. Language depends on the most naive prejudices. Now we read disharmonies and problems into things because we think only in the form of language—and thus believe in the “eternal truth” of “reason” (e.g., subject,

attribute, etc.) We cease to think when we refuse to do so under the constraint of language; we barely reach the doubt that sees this limitation as a limitation. Rational thought is interpretation according to a scheme that we cannot throw off.

523 (March-June 1888)

Nothing is more erroneous than to make of psychical and physical phenomena the two faces, the two revelations of one and the same substance. Nothing is explained thereby: the concept “substance” is perfectly useless as an explanation. Consciousness in a subsidiary role, almost indifferent, superfluous, perhaps destined to vanish and give way to a perfect automatism— When we observe only the inner phenomena we may be compared with the deaf-and-dumb, who divine through movements of the lips the words they do not hear. From the phenomena of the inner sense we conclude the existence of invisible and other phenomena that we would apprehend if our means of observation were adequate and that one calls the nerve current. We lack any sensitive organs for this inner world, so we sense a thousandfold complexity as a unity; so we introduce causation where any reason for motion and change remains invisible to us—the sequence of thoughts and feelings is only their becoming-visible in consciousness. That this sequence has anything to do with a causal chain is completely unbelievable: consciousness has never furnished us with an example of cause and effect.

524 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The role of “consciousness.”— It is essential that one should not make a mistake over the role of “consciousness”: it is our relation with the “outer world” that evolved it. On the other hand, the direction or protection and care in respect of the co-ordination of the bodily functions does not enter our consciousness; any more than spiritual accumulation: that a higher court rules over these things cannot be doubted—a kind of directing committee on which the various chief desires make their votes and power felt. “Pleasure,” “displeasure” are hints from this sphere; also the act of will; also ideas. In summa: That which becomes conscious is involved in causal relations which are entirely withheld from us—the sequence of thoughts, feelings, ideas in consciousness does not signify that this sequence is a causal sequence; but apparently it is so, to the highest degree. Upon this appearance we have founded our whole idea of spirit, reason, logic, etc. (—none of these exist: they are fictitious syntheses and unities), and projected these into things and behind things! Usually, one takes consciousness itself as the general sensorium and supreme court; nonetheless, it is only a means of communication: it is evolved through social intercourse and with a view to the interests of social intercourse— “Intercourse” here understood to include the influences of the outer world and the reactions they compel on our side; also our effect upon the outer world. It is not the directing agent, but an organ of the directing agent. 525 (1888) My proposition compressed into a formula that smells of antiquity, Christianity, scholasticism, and other muskiness: in the concept “God as spirit,” God as perfection is negated—

526 (March-June 1888)

Where a certain unity obtains in the grouping of things, one has always posited spirit as the cause of this coordination: for which notion there is no ground whatever. Why should the idea of a complex fact be one of the conditions of this fact? or why should the notion of a complex fact have to precede it as its cause? — We shall be on our guard against explaining purposiveness in terms of spirit: there is no ground whatever for ascribing to spirit the properties of organization and systematization. The nervous system has a much more extensive domain; the world of consciousness is added to it. Consciousness plays no role in the total process of adaptation and systematization. 527 (1886-1887) Physiologists, like philosophers, believe that consciousness increases in value in proportion as it increases in clarity: the clearest consciousness, the most logical and coldest thinking, is supposed to be of the first rank. However—by what measure is this value determined?— In regard to release of will, the most superficial, most simplified thinking is the most useful—it could therefore—etc. (because it leaves few motives over). Precision in action is antagonistic to far-seeing providentiality, the judgments of which are often uncertain: the latter is led by the deeper instinct. 528 (1886-1887) Principal error of psychologists: they regard the indistinct idea as a lower kind of idea than the distinct: but that which removes itself from our consciousness and for that reason becomes obscure can on that account be perfectly clear in itself. Becoming obscure is a matter of perspective of consciousness.

529 (March-June 1888)

Tremendous blunders: the absurd overestimation of consciousness, the transformation of it into a unity, an entity: “spirit,” “soul,” something that feels, thinks, wills— spirit as cause, especially wherever purposiveness, system, coordination appear; consciousness as the highest achievable form, as the supreme kind of being, as “God”; will introduced wherever there are effects; the “real world” as a spiritual world, as accessible through the facts of consciousness; knowledge as uniquely the faculty of consciousness wherever there is knowledge at all. Consequences: every advance lies in an advance in becoming conscious; every regression in becoming unconscious; (—becoming unconscious was considered a falling back to the desires and senses—as becoming animal—) one approaches reality, “real being,” through dialectic; one distances oneself from it through the instincts, senses, mechanism— to resolve man into spirit would mean to make him into God: spirit, will, goodness—all one; all good must proceed from spirituality, must be a fact of consciousness; any advance toward the better can only be an advance in becoming conscious. 530 (1883-1888) In the case of Kant, theological prejudice, his unconscious dogmatism, his moralistic perspective, were dominant, directing, commanding. The proton pseudos:10 how is the fact of knowledge possible? is knowledge a fact at all? what is knowledge? If we do not know what knowledge is, we cannot possibly answer the question whether there is knowledge.— Very well! But if I do not already “know” whether there is knowledge, whether there can be knowledge, I cannot reasonably put the question “what is knowledge?” Kant believes in the fact of knowledge: what he wants is a piece of naïveté: knowledge of knowledge! “Knowledge is judgment!” But judgment is a belief that something is thus and thus! And not knowledge! “All knowledge consists of synthetic judgments” of universal validity (the case is thus and not otherwise in every case), of necessary validity (the opposite of the assertion can never occur). The legitimacy of belief in knowledge is always presupposed: just as the legitimacy of the feelings of conscience-judgments is presupposed. Here moral ontology is the dominant prejudice. The conclusion is therefore: there are assertions that we consider universally valid and necessary; necessity and universal validity cannot be derived from experience; consequently they must be founded, not upon experience, but upon something else, and derive from another source of knowledge! (Kant infers (1) there are assertions which are valid only under a certain condition; (2) this condition is that they derive, not from experience, but from pure reason.) Therefore: the question is, whence do we derive our reasons for believing in the truth of such assertions? No, how our belief is caused! But the origin of a belief, of a strong conviction, is a psychological problem: and a very narrow and limited experience often produces such a belief! It already presupposes that there is not “data a posteriori” but also

data a priori, “preceding experience.” Necessity and universal validity could never be given to us by experience: why does that mean that they are present without any experience at all? There are no isolated judgments! An isolated judgment is never “true,” never knowledge; only in the connection and relation of many judgments is there any surety. What distinguishes the true from the false belief? What is knowledge? He “knows” it, that is heavenly! Necessity and universality can never be given by experience! Thus they are independent of experience, prior to all experience! That insight that occurs a priori, therefore independently of all experience, out of sheer reason, is “a pure form of knowledge”! “The basic laws of logic, the law of identity and the law of contradiction, are forms of pure knowledge, because they precede all experience.”— But these are not forms of knowledge at all! they are regulative articles of belief. To establish the a priori character (the pure rationality) of the judgments of mathematics, space must be conceived as a form of pure reason. Hume had declared: “There are no synthetic a priori judgments.” Kant says: But there are! Those of mathematics! And if there are such judgments, perhaps there is also metaphysics, a knowledge of things by pure reason! Mathematics is possible under conditions under which metaphysics is never possible. All human knowledge is either experience or mathematics. A judgment is synthetic; i.e., it connects different ideas. It is a priori; i.e., every connection is a universally valid and necessary one, which can never be given by sense perception but only through pure reason. If there are to be synthetic a priori judgments, then reason must be in a position to make connections: connection is a form. Reason must possess the capacity of giving form. 531 (1885-1886) Judgment is our oldest belief, our most habitual holding-true or holding-untrue, an assertion or denial, a certainty that something is thus and not otherwise, a belief that here we really “know”— what is it that is believed true in all judgments? What are attributes?— We have not regarded change in us as change but as an “in itself” that is foreign to us, that we merely “perceive”: and we have posited it, not as an event, but as a being, as a “quality”—and in addition invented an entity to which it adheres; i.e., we have regarded the effect as something that effects, and this we have regarded as a being. But even in this formulation, the concept “effect” is arbitrary: for those changes that take place in us, and that we firmly believe we have not ourselves caused, we merely infer to be effects, in accordance with the conclusion: “every change must have an author”;—but this conclusion is already mythology: it separates that which effects from the effecting. If I say “lightning flashes,” I have posited the flash once as an activity and a second time as a subject, and thus added to the event a being that is not one with the event but is rather fixed, is, and does not “become.”— To regard an event as an “effecting,” and this as being, that is the double error, or interpretation, of which we are guilty. 532 (1885) Judgment—this is the belief: “This and that are so.” Thus

there is in every judgment the avowal of having encountered an “identical case”: it therefore presupposes comparison with the aid of memory. The judgment does not produce the appearance of an identical case. Rather it believes it perceives one: it works under the presupposition that identical cases exist. Now, what is that function that must be much older and must have been at work much earlier, that makes cases identical and similar which are in themselves dissimilar? What is that second function, which on the basis of the first, etc. “Whatever arouses the same sensation is the same”: but what is it that makes sensations the same, “accepts” them as the same? There could be no judgments at all if a kind of equalization were not practiced within sensations: memory is possible only with a continual emphasizing of what is already familiar, experienced.— Before judgment occurs, the process of assimilation must already have taken place; thus here, too, there is an intellectual activity that does not enter consciousness, as pain does as a consequence of a wound. Probably an inner event corresponds to each organic function; hence assimilation, rejection, growth, etc. Essential: to start from the body and employ it as guide. It is the much richer phenomenon, which allows of clearer observation. Belief in the body is better established than belief in the spirit. “No matter how strongly a thing may be believed, strength of belief is no criterion of truth.” But what is truth? Perhaps a kind of belief that has become a condition of life? In that case, to be sure, strength could be a criterion; e.g., in regard to causality.

533 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Logical certainty, transparency, as criterion of truth (“*omne illud verum est, quod clare et distincte percipitur.*”¹¹—Descartes) : with that, the mechanical hypothesis concerning the world is desired and credible. But this is a crude confusion: like *simplex sigillum veri*.¹² How does one know that the real nature of things stands in this relation to our intellect?— Could it not be otherwise? that it is the hypothesis that gives the intellect the greatest feeling of power and security, that is most preferred, valued and consequently characterized as true?— The intellect posits its freest and strongest capacity and capability as criterion of the most valuable, consequently of the true— “True”: from the standpoint of feeling—: that which excites the feeling most strongly (“ego”); from the standpoint of thought—: that which gives thought the greatest feeling of strength; from the standpoint of touch, seeing, hearing—: that which calls for the greatest resistance. Thus it is the highest degrees of performance that awaken belief in the “truth,” that is to say reality, of the object. The feeling of strength, of struggle, of resistance convinces us that there is something that is here being resisted. 534 (1887-1888) The criterion of truth resides in the enhancement of the feeling of power. 535 (1885)¹³ “Truth”: this, according to my way of thinking, does not necessarily denote the antithesis of error, but in the most fundamental cases only the posture of various errors in relation to one another. Perhaps one is older, more profound than another, even ineradicable, in so far as an organic entity of our species could not live without it; while other errors do not tyrannize over us in this way as conditions of life, but on the contrary when compared with such “tyrants” can be set aside and “refuted.” An assumption that is irrefutable—why should it for that reason be “true”? This proposition may perhaps outrage logicians, who posit their limitations as the limitations of things: but I long ago declared war on this optimism of logicians.

536 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Everything simple is merely imaginary, is not “true.” But whatever is real, whatever is true, is neither one nor even, reducible to one. 537 (1885-1888) What is truth?—Inertia; that hypothesis which gives rise to contentment; smallest expenditure of spiritual force, etc. 538 (1883-1888) First proposition. The easier mode of thought conquers the harder mode;—as dogma: simplex sigillum veri.—Dico:14 to suppose that clarity proves anything about truth is perfect childishness — Second proposition. The doctrine of being, of things, of all sorts of fixed unities is a hundred times easier than the doctrine of becoming, of development — Third proposition. Logic was intended as facilitation; as a means of expression—not as truth— Later it acquired the effect of truth—

539 (March-June 1888)

Parmenides said, “one cannot think of what is not”;—we are at the other extreme, and say “what can be thought of must certainly be a fiction.”¹⁵ 540 (1885) There are many kinds of eyes. Even the sphinx has eyes— and consequently there are many kinds of “truths,” and consequently there is no truth.

541 (March-June 1888)

Inscriptions for the Door of a Modern Madhouse “What is thought necessarily is morally necessary.” Herbert Spencer. “The ultimate test of the truth of a proposition is the inconceivability of its negation.” Herbert Spencer.¹⁶

542 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

If the character of existence should be false—which would be possible—what would truth, all our truth, be then?—An unconscionable falsification of the false? The false raised to a higher power?—

543 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

In a world that is essentially false, truthfulness would be an antinatural tendency: such a tendency could have meaning only as a means to a higher power of falsehood. In order for a world of the true, of being, to be invented, the truthful man would first have to be created (including the fact that such a man believes himself “truthful”). Simple, transparent, not in contradiction with himself, durable, remaining always the same, without wrinkle, volt, concealment, form: a man of this kind conceives a world of being as “God” in his own image. For truthfulness to be possible, the whole sphere of man must be very clean, small and, respectable; advantage in every sense must be with the truthful man.— Lies, deception, dissimulation must arouse astonishment— 544 (1885-1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888) Increase in “dissimulation” proportionate to the rising order of rank of creatures. It seems to be lacking in the inorganic world— power against power, quite crudely—cunning begins in the organic world; plants are already masters of it. The highest human beings, such as Caesar, Napoleon (Stendhal’s remark on him),¹⁷ also the higher races (Italians), the Greeks (Odysseus); a thousandfold craftiness belongs to the essence of the enhancement of man— Problem of the actor. My Dionysus ideal— The perspective of all organic functions, all the strongest instincts of life: the force in all life that wills error; error as the precondition even of thought. Before there is “thought” there must have been “invention”;¹⁸ the construction of identical cases, of the appearance of sameness, is more primitive than the knowledge of sameness. 545 (1885) I believe in absolute space as the substratum of force: the latter limits and forms. Time eternal. But space and time do not exist in themselves. “Changes” are only appearances (or sense processes for us); if we posit the recurrence of these, however regular, nothing is established thereby except this simple fact, that it has always happened thus. The feeling that post hoc is propter hoc can easily be shown to be a misunderstanding; it is comprehensible. But appearances cannot be “causes”! 546 (1885-1886) The interpretation of an event as either an act or the suffering of an act (—thus every act a suffering) says: every change, every becoming-other, presupposes an author and someone upon whom “change” is effected. 547 (1885-1886) Psychological history of the concept “subject.” The body, the thing, the “whole” construed by the eye, awaken the distinction between a deed and a doer; the doer, the cause of the deed, conceived ever more subtly, finally left behind the “subject.” 548 (1885-1886) Our bad habit of taking a mnemonic, an abbreviative formula, to be an entity, finally as a cause, e.g., to say of lightning “it flashes.” Or the little word “I.” To make a kind of perspective in seeing the cause of seeing: that was what happened in the invention of the “subject,” the “I”! 549 (1885) “Subject,” “object,” “attribute”—these distinctions are fabricated and are now imposed as a schematism upon all the apparent facts.

The fundamental false observation is that I believe it is I who do something, suffer something, “have” something, “have” a quality. 550 (1885-1886) In every judgment there resides the entire, full, profound belief in subject and attribute, or in cause and effect (that is, as the assertion that every effect is an activity and that every activity presupposes an agent); and this latter belief is only a special case of the former, so there remains as the fundamental belief the belief that there are subjects, that everything that happens is related attributively to some subject.¹⁹ I notice something and seek a reason for it; this means originally: I seek an intention in it, and above all someone who has intentions, a subject, a doer: every event a deed—formerly one saw intentions in all events, this is our oldest habit. Do animals also possess it? As living beings, must they not also rely on interpretations based on themselves?— The question “why?” is always a question after the *causa finalis*,²⁰ after the “what for?” We have no “sense for the *causa efficiens*”:²¹ here Hume was right; habit (but not only that of the individual!) makes us expect that a certain often-observed occurrence will follow another: nothing more! That which gives the extraordinary firmness to our belief in causality is not the great habit of seeing one occurrence following another but our inability to interpret events otherwise than as events caused by intentions. It is belief in the living and thinking as the only effective force—in will, in intention—it is belief that every event is a deed, that every deed presupposes a doer, it is belief in the “subject.” Is this belief in the concept of subject and attribute not a great stupidity? Question: is intention the cause of an event? Or is that also illusion? Is it not the event itself?

551 (March-June 1888)

Critique of the concept “cause.”²²— We have absolutely no experience of a cause; psychologically considered, we derive the entire concept from the subjective conviction that we are causes, namely, that the arm moves— But that is an error. We separate ourselves, the doers, from the deed, and we make use of this pattern everywhere—we seek a doer for every event. What is it we have done? We have misunderstood the feeling of strength, tension, resistance, a muscular feeling that is already the beginning of the act, as the cause, or we have taken the will to do this or that for a cause because the action follows upon it— cause, i.e.,— There is no such thing as “cause”; some cases in which it seemed to be given us, and in which we have projected it out of ourselves in order to understand an event, have been shown to be self-deceptions. Our “understanding of an event” has consisted in our inventing a subject which was made responsible for something that happens and for how it happens. We have combined our feeling of will, our feeling of “freedom,” our feeling of responsibility and our intention to perform an act, into the concept “cause”: *causa efficiens* and *causa finalis* are fundamentally one. We believed that an effect was explained when a condition was detected in which the effect was already inherent. In fact, we invent all causes after the schema of the effect: the latter is known to us— Conversely, we are not in a position to predict of any thing what it will “effect.” The thing, the subject, will, intention—all inherent in the conception “cause.” We search for things in order to explain why something has changed. Even the atom is this kind of super-added “thing” and “primitive subject”— At length we grasp that things—consequently atoms, too— effect nothing: because they do not exist at all—that the concept of causality is completely useless.— A necessary sequence of states does not imply a causal relationship between them (—that would mean making their effective capacity leap from 1 to 2, to 3, to 4, to 5). There are neither causes nor effects. Linguistically we do not know how to rid ourselves of them. But that does not matter. If I think of the muscle apart from its “effects,” I negate it— In summa: an event is neither effected nor does it effect. *Causa* is a capacity to produce effects that has been super-added to the events— Interpretation by causality a deception— A “thing” is the sum of its effects, synthetically united by a concept, an image. In fact, science has emptied the concept causality of its content and retained it as a formula of an equation, in which it has become at bottom a matter of indifference on which side cause is placed and on which side effect. It is asserted that in two complex states (constellations of force) the quanta of force remain constant. The calculability of an event does not reside in the fact that a rule is adhered to, or that a necessity is obeyed, or that a law of causality has been projected by us into every event: it resides in the recurrence of “identical cases.” There is no such thing as a sense of

causality, as Kant thinks. One is surprised, one is disturbed, one desires something familiar to hold on to— As soon as we are shown something old in the new, we are calmed. The supposed instinct for causality is only fear of the unfamiliar and the attempt to discover something familiar in it—a search, not for causes, but for the familiar.

552 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Against determinism and teleology.— From the fact that something ensues regularly and ensues calculably, it does not follow that it ensues necessarily. That a quantum of force determines and conducts itself in every particular case in one way and manner does not make it into an “unfree will.” “Mechanical necessity” is not a fact: it is we who first interpreted it into events. We have interpreted the formulatable character of events as the consequence of a necessity that rules over events. But from the fact that I do a certain thing, it by no means follows that I am compelled to do it. Compulsion in things certainly cannot be demonstrated: the rule proves only that one and the same event is not another event as well. Only because we have introduced subjects, “doers,” into things does it appear that all events are the consequences of compulsion exerted upon subjects—exerted by whom? again by a “doer.” Cause and effect—a dangerous concept so long as one thinks of something that causes and something upon which an effect is produced. a. Necessity is not a fact but an interpretation. * b. When one has grasped that the “subject” is not something that creates effects, but only a fiction, much follows. It is only after the model of the subject that we have invented the reality of things and projected them into the medley of sensations. If we no longer believe in the effective subject, then belief also disappears in effective things, in reciprocation, cause and effect between those phenomena that we call things. There also disappears, of course, the world of effective atoms: the assumption of which always depended on the supposition that one needed subjects. At last, the “thing-in-itself” also disappears, because this is fundamentally the conception of a “subject-in-itself.” But we have grasped that the subject is a fiction. The antithesis “thing-in-itself” and “appearance” is untenable; with that, however, the concept “appearance” also disappears. * c. If we give up the effective subject, we also give up the object upon which effects are produced. Duration, identity with itself, being are inherent neither in that which is called subject nor in that which is called object: they are complexes of events apparently durable in comparison with other complexes—e.g., through the difference in tempo of the event (rest—motion, firm—loose: opposites that do not exist in themselves and that actually express only variations in degree that from a certain perspective appear to be opposites. There are no opposites:23 only from those of logic do we derive the concept of opposites—and falsely transfer it to things). d. If we give up the concept “subject” and “object,” then also the concept “substance”—and as a consequence also the various modifications of it, e.g., “matter,” “spirit,” and other hypothetical entities, “the eternity and immutability of matter,” etc. We have got rid of materiality. * From the standpoint of morality, the world is false. But to the extent that morality itself is a part of this world, morality is false. Will to truth is a making firm, a making true

and durable, an abolition of the false character of things, a reinterpretation of it into beings. “Truth” is therefore not something there, that might be found or discovered—but something that must be created and that gives a name to a process, or rather to a will to overcome that has in itself no end—introducing truth, as a *processus in infinitum*, an active determining—not a becoming-conscious of something that is in itself firm and determined. It is a word for the “will to power.” Life is founded upon the premise of a belief in enduring and regularly recurring things; the more powerful life is, the wider must be the knowable world to which

Appendix C

The Will to Power

Translated by Walter Kaufmann & R.J. Hollingdale

Book Three — Four: (Part 2)

we, as it were, attribute being. Logicizing, rationalizing, systematizing as expedients of life. Man projects his drive to truth, his “goal” in a certain sense, outside himself as a world that has being, as a metaphysical world, as a “thing-in-itself,” as a world already in existence. His needs as creator invent the world upon which he works, anticipate it; this anticipation (this “belief” in truth) is his support. * All events, all motion, all becoming, as a determination of degrees and relations of force, as a struggle— * As soon as we imagine someone who is responsible for our being thus and thus, etc. (God, nature), and therefore attribute to him the intention that we should exist and be happy or wretched, we corrupt for ourselves the innocence of becoming.²⁴ We then have someone who wants to achieve something through us and with us. * The “welfare of the individual” is just as imaginary as the “welfare of the species”: the former is not sacrificed to the latter, species viewed from a distance is just as transient as the individual. “Preservation of the species” is only a consequence of the growth of the species, i.e., the overcoming of the species on the road to a stronger type. * [Theses.—]²⁵ That the apparent “purposiveness” (“that purposiveness which endlessly surpasses all the arts of man”) is merely the consequence of the will to power manifest in all events; that becoming stronger involves an ordering process which looks like a sketchy purposiveness; that apparent ends are not intentional but, as soon as dominion is established over a lesser power and the latter operates as a function of the greater power, an order of rank, of organization is bound to produce the appearance of an order of means and ends. Against apparent “necessity”: —this is only an expression for the fact that a force is not also something else. Against apparent “purposiveness”: —the latter only an expression for an order of spheres of power and their interplay. 553 (1886-1887) The sore spot of Kant’s critical philosophy has gradually become visible even to dull eyes: Kant no longer has a right to his distinction “appearance” and “thing-in-itself”—he had deprived himself of the right to go on distinguishing in this old familiar way, in so far as he rejected as impermissible making inferences from phenomena to a cause of phenomena—in accordance with his conception of causality and its purely intra-phenomenal validity— which conception, on the

other hand, already anticipates this distinction, as if the “thing-in-itself” were not only inferred but given. 554 (1885-1886) Causalism.²⁶— It is obvious that things-in-themselves cannot be related to one another as cause and effect, nor can appearance be so related to appearance; from which it follows that in a philosophy that believes in things-in-themselves and appearances the concept “cause and effect” cannot be applied. Kant’s mistakes—In fact, the concept “cause and effect” derives, psychologically speaking, only from a mode of thought that believes that always and everywhere will operates upon will—that believes only in living things and fundamentally only in “souls” (and not in things). Within the mechanistic view of the world (which is logic and its application to space and time), that concept is reduced to the formulas of mathematics—with which, as one must emphasize again and again, nothing is ever comprehended, but rather designated and distorted.²⁷ 555 (1885-1886) Against the scientific prejudice.²⁸— The biggest fable of all is the fable of knowledge. One would like to know what things-in-themselves are; but behold, there are no things-in-themselves! But even supposing there were an in-itself, an unconditioned thing, it would for that very reason be unknowable! Something unconditioned cannot be known; otherwise it would not be unconditioned! Coming to know, however, is always “placing oneself in a conditional relation to something”—one who seeks to know the unconditioned desires that it should not concern him, and that this same something should be of no concern to anyone. This involves a contradiction, first, between wanting to know and the desire that it not concern us (but why know at all, then?) and, secondly, because something that is of no concern to anyone is not at all, and thus cannot be known at all.— Coming to know means “to place oneself in a conditional relation to something”; to feel oneself conditioned by something and oneself to condition it—it is therefore under all circumstances establishing, denoting, and making-conscious of conditions (not forthcoming entities, things, what is “in-itself”). 556 (1885-1886) A “thing-in-itself” just as perverse as a “sense-in-itself,” a “meaning-in-itself.” There are no “facts-in-themselves,” for a sense must always be projected into them before there can be “facts.” The question “what is that?” is an imposition of meaning from some other viewpoint. “Essence,” the “essential nature,” is something perspective and already presupposes a multiplicity. At the bottom of it there always lies “what is that for me?” (for us, for all that lives, etc.) A thing would be defined once all creatures had asked “what is that?” and had answered their question. Supposing one single creature, with its own relationships and perspectives for all things, were missing, then the thing would not yet be “defined.” In short: the essence of a thing is only an opinion about the “thing.” Or rather: “it is considered” is the real “it is,” the sole “this is.” One may not ask: “who then interprets?” for the interpretation itself is a form of the will to power, exists (but not as a “being” but as a process, a

becoming) as an affect. The origin of “things” is wholly the work of that which imagines, thinks, wills, feels. The concept “thing” itself just as much as all its qualities.— Even “the subject” is such a created entity, a “thing” like all others: a simplification with the object of defining the force which posits, invents, thinks, as distinct from all individual positing, inventing, thinking as such. Thus a capacity as distinct from all that is individual—fundamentally, action collectively considered with respect to all anticipated actions (action and the probability of similar actions). 557 (1885-1886) The properties of a thing are effects on other “things”: if one removes other “things,” then a thing has no properties, i.e., there is no thing without other things, i.e., there is no “thing-in-itself.”

558 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The “thing-in-itself” nonsensical. If I remove all the relationships, all the “properties,” all the “activities” of a thing, the thing does not remain over; because thingness has only been invented by us owing to the requirements of logic, thus with the aim of defining, communication (to bind together the multiplicity of relationships, properties, activities).

559 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

“Things that have a constitution in themselves”—a dogmatic idea with which one must break absolutely. 560 (Spring-Fall 1887). That things possess a constitution in themselves quite apart from interpretation and subjectivity, is a quite idle hypothesis: it presupposes that interpretation and subjectivity are not essential, that a thing freed from all relationships would still be a thing. Conversely, the apparent objective character of things: could it not be merely a difference of degree within the subjective?—that perhaps that which changes slowly presents itself to us as “objectively” enduring, being, “in-itself”—that the objective is only a false concept of a genus and an antithesis within the subjective? 561 (1885-1886) Suppose all unity were unity only as an organization? But the “thing” in which we believe was only invented as a foundation for the various attributes. If the thing “effects,” that means: we conceive all the other properties which are present and momentarily latent, as the cause of the emergence of one single property; i.e., we take the sum of its properties—“X”—as cause of the property “x”: which is utterly stupid and mad! All unity is unity only as organization and co-operation—just as a human community is a unity—as opposed to an atomistic anarchy, as a pattern of domination that signifies a unity but is not a unity. 562 (1883-1888) “In the development of thought a point had to be reached at which one realized that what one called the properties of things were sensations of the feeling subject: at this point the properties ceased to belong to the thing.” The “thing-in-itself” remained. The distinction between the thing-in-itself and the thing-for-us is based on the older, naive form of perception which granted energy to things; but analysis revealed that even force was only projected into them, and likewise—substance. “The thing affects a subject”? Root of the idea of substance in language, not in beings outside us! The thing-in-itself is no problem at all! Beings will have to be thought of as sensations that are no longer based on something devoid of sensation. In motion, no new content is given to sensation. That which is, cannot contain motion: therefore it is a form of being. N.B. The explanation of an event can be sought firstly: through mental images of the event that precede it (aims); secondly: through mental images that succeed it (the mathematical-physical explanation). One should not confuse the two. Thus: the physical explanation, which is a symbolization of the world by means of sensation and thought, can in itself never account for the origin of sensation and thought; rather physics must construe the world of feeling consistently as lacking feeling and aim—right up to the highest human being. And teleology is only a history of purposes and never physical! 563 (1886-1887) Our “knowing” limits itself to establishing quantities; but we cannot help feeling these differences in quantity as qualities. Quality is a perspective truth for us; not an “in-itself.” Our

senses have a definite quantum as a mean within which they function; i.e., we sense bigness and smallness in relation to the conditions of our existence. If we sharpened or blunted our senses tenfold, we should perish; ie, with regard to making possible our existence we sense even relations between magnitudes as qualities. 564 (1885-1886) Might all quantities not be signs of qualities? A greater power implies a different consciousness, feeling, desiring, a different perspective; growth itself is a desire to be more; the desire for an increase in quantum grows from a quale;²⁹ in a purely quantitative world everything would be dead, stiff, motionless.— The reduction of all qualities to quantities is nonsense: what appears is that the one accompanies the other, an analogy—

565 (Fall 1886)

Qualities are insurmountable barriers for us; we cannot help feeling that mere quantitative differences are something fundamentally distinct from quantity, namely that they are qualities which can no longer be reduced to one another. But everything for which the word “knowledge” makes any sense refers to the domain of reckoning, weighing, measuring, to the domain of quantity; while, on the other hand, all our sensations of value (i.e., simply our sensations) adhere precisely to qualities, i.e., to our perspective “truths” which belong to us alone and can by no means be “known”! It is obvious that every creature different from us senses different qualities and consequently lives in a different world from that in which we live. Qualities are an idiosyncrasy peculiar to man; to demand that our human interpretations and values should be universal and perhaps constitutive values is one of the hereditary madneses of human pride.

566 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The “real world,” however one has hitherto conceived it— it has always been the apparent world once again.³⁰

567 (March-June 1888)

The apparent world, i.e., a world viewed according to values; ordered, selected according to values, i.e., in this case according to the viewpoint of utility in regard to the preservation and enhancement of the power of a certain species of animal. The perspective therefore decides the character of the “appearance”! As if a world would still remain over after one deducted the perspective! By doing that one would deduct relativity! Every center of force adopts a perspective toward the entire remainder, i.e., its own particular valuation, mode of action, and mode of resistance. The “apparent world,” therefore, is reduced to a specific mode of action on the world, emanating from a center. Now there is no other mode of action whatever; and the “world” is only a word for the totality of these actions. Reality consists precisely in this particular action and reaction of every individual part toward the whole— No shadow of a right remains to speak here of appearance— The specific mode of reacting is the only mode of reacting; we do not know how many and what kinds of other modes there are. But there is no “other,” no “true,” no essential being—for this would be the expression of a world without action and reaction— The antithesis of the apparent world and the true world is reduced to the antithesis “world” and “nothing.”—

568 (March-June 1888)

Critique of the concept “true and apparent world.”— Of these, the first is a mere fiction, constructed of fictitious entities. “Appearance” itself belongs to reality: it is a form of its being; i.e., in a world where there is no being, a certain calculable world of identical cases must first be created through appearance: a tempo at which observation and comparison are possible, etc. Appearance is an arranged and simplified world, at which our practical instincts have been at work; it is perfectly true for us; that is to say, we live, we are able to live in it: proof of its truth for us— the world, apart from our condition of living in it, the world that we have not reduced to our being, our logic and psychological prejudices, does not exist as a world “in-itself”; it is essentially a world of relationships; under certain conditions it has a differing aspect from every point; its being is essentially different from every point; it presses upon every point, every point resists it—and the sum of these is in every case quite incongruent. The measure of power determines what being possesses the other measure of power; in what form, force, constraint it acts or resists. Our particular case is interesting enough: we have produced a conception in order to be able to live in a world, in order to perceive just enough to endure it—

569 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Our psychological perspective is determined by the following: that communication is necessary, and that for there to be communication something has to be firm, simplified, capable of precision (above all in the [so-called]³² identical case). For it to be communicable, however, it must be experienced as adapted, as “recognizable.” The material of the senses adapted by the understanding, reduced to rough outlines, made similar, subsumed under related matters. Thus the fuzziness and chaos of sense impressions are, as it were, logicized; the world of “phenomena” is the adapted world which we feel to be real. The “reality” lies in the continual recurrence of identical, familiar, related things in their logicized character, in the belief that here we are able to reckon and calculate; the antithesis of this phenomenal world is not “the true world,” but the formless unformulable world of the chaos of sensations—another kind of phenomenal world, a kind “unknowable” for us; questions, what things “in-themselves” may be like, apart from our sense receptivity and the activity of our understanding, must be rebutted with the question: how could we know that things exist? “Thingness” was first created by us. The question is whether there could not be many other ways of creating such an apparent world—and whether this creating, logicizing, adapting, falsifying is not itself the best-guaranteed reality; in short, whether that which “posits things” is not the sole reality; and whether the “effect of the external world upon us” is not also only the result of such active subjects—The other “entities” act upon us; our adapted apparent world is an adaptation and overpowering of their actions; a kind of defensive measure. The subject alone is demonstrable; hypothesis that only subjects exist—that “object” is only a kind of effect produced by a subject upon a subject—a modus of the subject.

570 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

If one is a philosopher as men have always been philosophers, one cannot see what has been and becomes—one sees only what is. But since nothing is, all that was left to the philosopher as his “world” was the imaginary.

571 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

To assert the existence as a whole of things of which we know nothing whatever, precisely because there is an advantage in not being able to know anything of them, was a piece of naïveté of Kant, resulting from needs, mainly moral-metaphysical. 572 (1883-1888) An artist cannot endure reality, he looks away from it, back: he seriously believes that the value of a thing resides in that shadowy residue one derives from colors, form, sound, ideas, he believes that the more subtilized, attenuated, transient a thing or a man is, the more valuable he becomes; the less real, the more valuable. This is Platonism, which, however, involved yet another bold reversal: Plato measured the degree of reality by the degree of value and said: The more “Idea,” the more being. He reversed the concept “reality” and said: “What you take for real is an error, and the nearer we approach the ‘Idea,’ the nearer we approach ‘truth.’ ”— Is this understood? It was the greatest of rebaptisms; and because it has been adopted by Christianity we do not recognize how astonishing it is. Fundamentally, Plato, as the artist he was, preferred appearance to being! lie and invention to truth! the unreal to the actual! But he was so convinced of the value of appearance that he gave it the attributes “being,” “causality” and “goodness,” and “truth,” in short everything men value. The concept of value itself considered as a cause: first insight. The ideal granted all honorific attributes: second insight.

573 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The idea of the “true world” or of “God” as absolutely immaterial, spiritual, good, is an emergency measure necessary while the opposite instincts are still all-powerful— The degree of moderation and humanity attained is exactly reflected in the humanization of the gods: the Greeks of the strongest epoch, who were not afraid of themselves but rejoiced in themselves, brought their gods close to all their own affects—. The spiritualization of the idea of God is therefore far from being a sign of progress: one is heartily conscious of this when considering Goethe—in his case, the vaporization of God into virtue and spirit is felt as being on a coarser level— 574 (1883-1888) Senselessness of all metaphysics as the derivation of the conditioned from the unconditioned. It is in the nature of thinking that it thinks of and invents the unconditioned as an adjunct to the conditioned; just as it thought of and invented the “ego” as an adjunct to the multiplicity of its processes; it measures the world according to magnitudes posited by itself—such fundamental fictions as “the unconditional,” “ends and means,” “things,” “substances,” logical laws, numbers and forms. There would be nothing that could be called knowledge if thought did not first re-form the world in this way into “things,” into what is self-identical. Only because there is thought is there untruth. Thought cannot be derived, any more than sensations can be; but that does not mean that its primordially or “being-in-itself” has been proved! all that is established is that we cannot get beyond it, because we have nothing but thought and sensation. 575 (1885-1886) “Knowledge” is a referring back: in its essence a regressus in infinitum. That which comes to a standstill (at a supposed *causa prima*, at something unconditioned, etc.) is laziness, weariness— 576 (1883-1888) Psychology of metaphysics: the influence of timidity. That which has been feared the most, the cause of the most powerful suffering (lust to rule, sex, etc.),³³ has been treated by men with the greatest amount of hostility and eliminated from the “true” world. Thus they have eliminated the affects one by one—posited God as the antithesis of evil, that is, placed reality in the negation of the desires and affects (i.e., in nothingness). In the same way, they have hated the irrational, the arbitrary, the accidental (as the causes of immeasurable physical suffering). As a consequence, they negated this element in being-in-itself and conceived it as absolute “rationality” and “purposiveness.” In the same way, they have feared change, transitoriness: this expresses a straitened soul, full of mistrust and evil experiences (the case of Spinoza: an opposite kind of man would account change a stimulus). A creature overloaded and playing with force would call precisely the affects, irrationality, and change good in a eudaemonistic sense, together with their consequences: danger, contrast, perishing, etc.

577 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Against the value of that which remains eternally the same (vide Spinoza's naiveté; Descartes' also), the values of the briefest and most transient, the seductive flash of gold on the belly of the serpent vita—

578 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Moral values even in theory of knowledge: trust in reason—why not mistrust? the “true world” is supposed to be the good world—why? appearance, change, contradiction, struggle devalued as immoral; desire for a world in which these things are missing; the transcendental world invented, in order that a place remains for “moral freedom” (in Kant); dialectic a way to virtue (in Plato and Socrates: evidently because Sophistry counted as the way to immorality); time and space ideal: consequently “unity” in the essence of things; consequently no “sin,” no evil, no imperfection—a justification of God; Epicurus denied the possibility of knowledge, in order to retain moral (or hedonistic) values as the highest values. Augustine, later Pascal (“corrupted reason”), did the same for the benefit of Christian values; Descartes’ contempt for everything that changes; also that of Spinoza. 579 (1883-1888) Psychology of metaphysics.— This world is apparent: consequently there is a true world;—this world is conditional: consequently there is an unconditioned world;—this world is full of contradiction: consequently there is a world free of contradiction;— this world is a world of becoming: consequently there is a world of being;—all false conclusions (blind trust in reason: if A exists, then the opposite concept ? must also exist). It is suffering that inspires these conclusions: fundamentally they are desires that such a world should exist; in the same way, to imagine another, more valuable world is an expression of hatred for a world that makes one suffer: the resentment of metaphysicians against actuality is here creative. Second series of questions: for what is there suffering?—and from this a conclusion is derived concerning the relation of the true world to our apparent, changing, suffering, contradictory world: (1) Suffering as a consequence of error: how is error possible? (2) Suffering as a consequence of guilt: how is guilt possible? (— experiences derived from nature or society universalized and projected to the sphere of “in-itself”). If, however, the conditioned world is causally conditioned by the unconditioned world, then freedom to err and incur guilt must also be conditioned by it: and again one asks, what for?— The world of appearance, becoming, contradiction, suffering, is therefore willed: what for? The error in these conclusions: two opposite concepts are constructed—because one of them corresponds to a reality, the other “must” also correspond to a reality. “Whence should one derive this opposite concept if this were not so?”— Reason is thus a source of revelation concerning being-in-itself. But the origin of these antitheses need not necessarily go back to a supernatural source of reason: it is sufficient to oppose to it the real genesis of the concepts. This derives from the practical sphere, the sphere of utility; hence the strength of the faith it inspires (one would perish if one did not reason according to this mode of reason; but this is no “proof” of what it asserts). The preoccupation with suffering on the part of

metaphysicians—is quite naive. “Eternal bliss”: psychological nonsense. Brave and creative men never consider pleasure and pain as ultimate values—they are epiphenomena: one must desire both if one is to achieve anything—. That they see the problem of pleasure and pain in the foreground reveals something weary and sick in metaphysicians and religious people. Even morality is so important to them only because they see in it an essential condition for the abolition of suffering. In the same way, their preoccupation with appearance and error: cause of suffering, superstition that happiness attends truth (confusion: happiness in “certainty,” in “faith”).

580 (Spring-Fall 1887)

To what extent the basic epistemological positions (materialism, idealism) are consequences of evaluations: the source of the supreme feelings of pleasure (“feelings of value”) as decisive also for the problem of reality! —The measure of positive knowledge is quite subsidiary or a matter of indifference: as witness the development of India. The Buddhistic negation of reality in general (appearance = suffering) is perfectly consistent: undemonstrability, inaccessibility, lack of categories not only for a “‘world-in-itself,” but an insight into the erroneous procedures by means of which this whole concept is arrived at. “Absolute reality,” “being-in-itself” a contradiction. In a world of becoming, “reality” is always only a simplification for practical ends, or a deception through the coarseness of organs, or a variation in the tempo of becoming. Logical world-denial and nihilation follow from the fact that we have to oppose non-being with being and that the concept “becoming” is denied. (“Something” becomes.)

581 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Being and becoming.—“Reason,” evolved on a sensualistic basis, on the prejudices of the senses, i.e., in the belief in the truth of the judgments of the senses. “Being” as universalization of the concept “life” (breathing), “having a soul,” “willing, effecting,” “becoming.” The antithesis is: “not to have a soul,” “not to become,” “not to will.” Therefore: “being” is not the antithesis of non-being, appearance, nor even of the dead (for only something that can live can be dead). The “soul,” the “ego” posited as primeval fact, and introduced everywhere where there is any becoming. 582 (1885-1887) Being—we have no idea of it apart from the idea of “living.”— How can anything dead “be”?

583 (March-June 1888)

(A) I observe with astonishment that science has today resigned itself to the apparent world; a real world—whatever it may be like—we certainly have no organ for knowing it. At this point we may ask: by means of what organ of knowledge can we posit even this antithesis?— That a world accessible to our organs is also understood to be dependent upon these organs, that we understand a world as being subjectively conditioned,³⁶ is not to say that an objective world is at all possible. Who compels us to think that subjectivity is real, essential? The “in-itself” is even an absurd conception; a “constitution-in-itself” is nonsense; we possess the concept “being,” “thing,” only as a relational concept— The worst thing is that with the old antithesis “apparent” and “true” the correlative value judgment “lacking in value” and “absolutely valuable” has developed. The apparent world is not counted as a “valuable” world; appearance is supposed to constitute an objection to supreme value. Only a “true” world can be valuable in itself— Prejudice of prejudices! Firstly, it would be possible that the true constitution of things was so hostile to the presuppositions of life, so opposed to them, that we needed appearance in order to be able to live— After all, this is the case in so many situations; e.g. in marriage. Our empirical world would be determined by the instincts of self-preservation even as regards the limits of its knowledge: we would regard as true, good, valuable that which serves the preservation of the species— a. We possess no categories by which we can distinguish a true from an apparent world. (There might only be an apparent world, but not our apparent world.) b. Assuming the true world, it could still be a world less valuable for us; precisely the quantum of illusion might be of a higher rank on account of its value for our preservation. (Unless appearance as such were grounds for condemnation?) c. That a correlation exists between degrees of value and degrees of reality (so that the supreme values also possess the supreme reality) is a metaphysical postulate proceeding from the presupposition that we know the order of rank of values; namely, that this order of rank is a moral order — Only with this presupposition is truth necessarily part of the definition of all the highest values. (B) It is of cardinal importance that one should abolish the true world. It is the great inspirer of doubt and devaluator in respect of the world we are: it has been our most dangerous attempt yet to assassinate life. War on all presuppositions on the basis of which one has invented a true world. Among these is the presupposition that moral values are the supreme values. The supremacy of moral valuation would be refuted if it could be shown to be the consequence of an immoral valuation—as a special case of actual immorality—it would thus reduce itself to an appearance, and as appearance it would cease to have any right as such to condemn appearance. (C) The “will to truth” would then have to be investigated psychologically: it is not a moral force, but a form of

the will to power. This would have to be proved by showing that it employs every immoral means: metaphysicians above all—. We are today faced with testing the assertion that moral values are the supreme values. Method in investigation is attained only when all moral prejudices have been overcome:—it represents a victory over morality—

584 (March-June 1888)

The aberration of philosophy is that, instead of seeing in logic and the categories of reason means toward the adjustment of the world for utilitarian ends (basically, toward an expedient falsification), one believed one possessed in them the criterion of truth and reality. The “criterion of truth” was in fact merely the biological utility of such a system of systematic falsification; and since a species of animals knows of nothing more important than its own preservation, one might indeed be permitted to speak here of “truth.” The naïveté was to take an anthropocentric idiosyncrasy as the measure of things, as the rule for determining “real” and “unreal”: in short, to make absolute something conditioned. And behold, suddenly the world fell apart into a “true” world and an “apparent” world: and precisely the world that man’s reason had devised for him to live and settle in was discredited. Instead of employing the forms as a tool for making the world manageable and calculable, the madness of philosophers divined that in these categories is presented the concept of that world to which the one in which man lives does not correspond—The means were misunderstood as measures of value, even as a condemnation of their real intention—The intention was to deceive oneself in a useful way; the means, the invention of formulas and signs by means of which one could reduce the confusing multiplicity to a purposive and manageable schema. But alas! now a moral category was brought into play: no creature wants to deceive itself, no creature may deceive—consequently there is only a will to truth. What is “truth”? The law of contradiction provided the schema: the true world, to which one seeks the way, cannot contradict itself, cannot change, cannot become, has no beginning and no end. This is the greatest error that has ever been committed, the essential fatality of error on earth: one believed one possessed a criterion of reality in the forms of reason—while in fact one possessed them in order to become master of reality, in order to misunderstand reality in a shrewd manner—And behold: now the world became false, and precisely on account of the properties that constitute its reality: change, becoming, multiplicity, opposition, contradiction, war. And then the entire fatality was there: 2. how can one become oneself as much as possible the antithesis of the character of the apparent world? (Concept of the perfect creature as an antithesis to the real creature; more clearly, as the contradiction of life—) The whole tendency of values was toward slander of life; one created a confusion of idealist dogmatism and knowledge in general: so that the opposing party also was always attacking science. The road to science was in this way doubly blocked: once by belief in the “true” world, and again by the opponents of this belief. Natural science, psychology was (1) condemned with regard to its objects, (2) deprived of its innocence—In the actual world, in which everything is bound to and conditioned by everything else, to condemn and think away anything

means to condemn and think away everything. The expression “that should not be,” “that should not have been,” is farcical— If one thinks out the consequences, one would ruin the source of life if one wanted to abolish whatever was in some respect harmful or destructive. Physiology teaches us better! —We see how morality (a) poisons the entire conception of the world, (b) cuts off the road to knowledge, to science, (c) disintegrates and undermines all actual instincts (in that it teaches that their roots are immoral). We see at work before us a dreadful tool of decadence that props itself up by the holiest names and attitudes.

585 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

Tremendous self-examination: becoming conscious of oneself, not as individuals but as mankind. Let us reflect, let us think back; let us follow the highways and byways! (A) Man seeks “the truth”: a world that is not self-contradictory, not deceptive, does not change, a true world—a world in which one does not suffer; contradiction, deception, change—causes of suffering! He does not doubt that a world as it ought to be exists; he would like to seek out the road to it. (Indian critique: even the “ego” as apparent, as not real) Whence does man here derive the concept reality?— Why is it that he derives suffering from change, deception, contradiction? and why not rather his happiness?— Contempt, hatred for all that perishes, changes, varies— whence comes this valuation of that which remains constant? Obviously, the will to truth is here merely the desire for a world of the constant. The senses deceive, reason corrects the errors; consequently, one concluded, reason is the road to the constant; the least sensual ideas must be closest to the “true world.”— It is from the senses that most misfortunes come—they are deceivers, deluders, destroyers.— Happiness can be guaranteed only by being; change and happiness exclude one another. The highest desire therefore contemplates unity with what has being. This is the formula for: the road to the highest happiness. In summa: the world as it ought to be exists; this world, in which we live, is an error—this world of ours ought not to exist. Belief in what has being is only a consequence: the real *primum mobile* is disbelief in becoming, mistrust of becoming, the low valuation of all that becomes— What kind of man reflects in this way? An unproductive, suffering kind, a kind weary of life. If we imagine the opposite kind of man, he would not need to believe in what has being; more, he would despise it as dead, tedious, indifferent— The belief that the world as it ought to be is, really exists, is a belief of the unproductive who do not desire to create a world as it ought to be. They posit it as already available, they seek ways and means of reaching it. “Will to truth”— as the impotence of the will to create. The fiction of a world that corresponds to our desires: psychological trick and interpretation with the aim of associating everything we honor and find pleasant with this true world. “Will to truth” at this stage is essentially an art of interpretation: which at least requires the power to interpret. This same species of man, grown one stage poorer, no longer possessing the strength to interpret, to create fictions, produces nihilists. A nihilist is a man who judges of the world as it is that it ought not to be. and of the world as it ought to be that it does not exist.³⁹ According to this view, our existence (action, suffering, willing, feeling) has no meaning: the pathos of “in vain” is the nihilists’ pathos—at the same time, as pathos, an inconsistency on the part of the nihilists. Whoever is incapable of laying his will into things, lacking will and strength, at least lays some meaning into them, i.e., the faith that

there is a will in them already.⁴⁰ It is a measure of the degree of strength of will to what extent one can do without meaning in things, to what extent one can endure to live in a meaningless world because one organizes a small portion of it oneself. The philosophical objective outlook can therefore be a sign that will and strength are small. For strength organizes what is close and closest; “men of knowledge,” who desire only to ascertain what is, are those who cannot fix anything as it ought to be. Artists, an intermediary species: they at least fix an image of that which ought to be; they are productive, to the extent that they actually alter and transform; unlike men of knowledge, who leave everything as it is.⁴¹ Connection between philosophers and the pessimistic religions: the same species of man (—they ascribe the highest degree of reality to the most highly valued things—). Connection between philosophers and moral men and their evaluations (—the moral interpretation of the world as meaning: after the decline of the religious meaning—). Overcoming of philosophers through the destruction of the world of being: intermediary period of nihilism: before there is yet present the strength to reverse values and to deify becoming and the apparent world as the only world, and to call them good. (B) Nihilism as a normal phenomenon can be a symptom of increasing strength or of increasing weakness: partly, because the strength to create, to will, has so increased that it no longer requires these total interpretations and introductions of meaning (“present tasks,” the state, etc.); partly because even the creative strength to create meaning has declined and disappointment becomes the dominant condition. The incapability of believing in a “meaning,” “unbelief.” What does science mean in regard to both possibilities? As a sign of strength and self-control, as being able to do without healing, comforting worlds of illusion; as undermining, dissecting, disappointing, weakening. (C) Belief in truth, the need to have a hold on something believed true, psychological reduction apart from all previous value feelings. Fear, laziness. The same way, unbelief: reduction. To what extent it acquires a new value if a true world does not exist (—thus the value feelings that hitherto have been squandered on the world of being, are again set free).

586 (March-June 1888)

The “True” and the “Apparent World” (A) The seductions that proceed from this concept are of three kinds: a. an unknown world:—we are adventurers, inquisitive— that which is known seems to weary us (—the danger of this concept lies in its insinuation that “this” world is known to us—); b. another world, where things are different; something in us calculates, our still submission, our silence, lose their value— perhaps everything will turn out well, we have not hoped in vain—the world where things are different, where we ourselves— who knows?—are different— c. a true world: this is the most amazing trick and attack that has ever been perpetrated upon us; so much has become encrusted in the word “true,” and involuntarily we make a present of all this to the “true world”: the true world must also be a truthful world, one that does not deceive us, does not make fools of us: to believe in it is virtually to be compelled to believe in it (—out of decency, as is the case among people worthy of confidence—). * The concept “the unknown world” insinuates that this world is “known” to us (is tedious—); the concept “another world” insinuates that the world could be otherwise—abolishes necessity and fate (useless to submit oneself—to adapt oneself—); the concept “the true world” insinuates that this world is untruthful, deceptive, dishonest, inauthentic, inessential—and consequently also not a world adapted to our needs (—inadvisable to adapt oneself to it; better to resist it). * We therefore elude “this” world in three ways: a. by our inquisitiveness—as if the more interesting part were elsewhere; b. by our submission—as though it were not necessary to submit oneself—as if this world were not a necessity of the ultimate rank: c. by our sympathy and respect—as if this world did not deserve them, were impure, were not honest with us— In summa. we have revolted in three ways: we have made an “x” into a critique of the “known world.” (B) First step toward sobriety: to grasp to what extent we have been seduced—for things could be exactly the reverse: a. the unknown world could be a stupid and meaner form of existence—and “this” world might be rather enjoyable by comparison; b. the other world, far from taking account of our desires which would find no fulfillment in it, could be among the mass of things that make this world possible for us: to get to know it might be a means of making us contented; c. the true world: but who is it really who tells us that the apparent world must be of less value than the true one? Does our instinct not contradict this judgment? Does man not eternally create a fictitious world for himself because he wants a better world than reality? Above all: how do we arrive at the idea that our world is not the true world?—it could be that the other world is the “apparent” one (in fact the Greeks thought of, e.g., a shadow kingdom, an apparent existence, beside true existence). And finally: what gives us the right to posit, as it were, degrees of reality? This is something different

from an unknown world— it is already a wanting to know something of the unknown— The “other,” the “unknown” world—very good! But to say “true world” means “to know something of it”— That is the opposite of the assumption of an “x” world— In summa: the world “x” could be in every sense more tedious, less human, and less worthy than this world. It would be another thing to assert the existence of “x” worlds, i.e., of every possible world besides this one. But this has never been asserted— (B) Problem: why the notion of another world has always been unfavorable for, or critical of “this” world—what does this indicate?— For a people proud of itself, whose life is ascending, always thinks of another kind of being as a lower, less valuable kind of being; it regards the strange, the unknown world as its enemy, as its opposite; it feels no inquisitiveness, it totally rejects the strange— A people would never admit that another people was the “true people.”— It is symptomatic that such a distinction should be at all possible—that one takes this world for the “apparent” one and the other world as “true.” The places of origin of the notion of “another world”: the philosopher, who invents a world of reason, where reason and the logical functions are adequate: this is the origin of the “true” world; the religious man, who invents a “divine world”: this is the origin of the “denaturalized, anti-natural” world; the moral man, who invents a “free world”: this is the origin of the “good, perfect, just, holy” world. What the three places of origin have in common: the psychological blunder, the physiological confusions. By what attributes is the “other world,” as it actually appears in history, distinguished? By the stigmata of philosophical, religious, moral prejudice. The “other world,” as illumined by these facts, as a synonym for nonbeing, nonliving, not wanting to live— General insight: it is the instinct of life-weariness, and not that of life, which has created the “other world.” Consequence: philosophy, religion, and morality are symptoms of decadence.⁴² 587 (1885-1886) It might seem as though I had evaded the question of “certainty.” The opposite is true; but by inquiring after the criterion of certainty I tested the scales upon which men have weighed in general hitherto—and that the question of certainty itself is a dependent question, a question of the second rank. 588 (1883-1886) The question of values is more fundamental than the question of certainty: the latter becomes serious only by presupposing that the value question has already been answered. Being and appearance, psychologically considered, yield no “being-in-itself,” no criterion of “reality,” but only for grades of appearance measured by the strength of the interest we show in an appearance. There is no struggle for existence between ideas and perceptions, but a struggle for dominion: the idea that is overcome is not annihilated, only driven back or subordinated. There is no annihilation in the sphere of spirit—⁴³ 589 (1885-1886) 590 (1885-1886) Our values are interpreted into things. Is there then any meaning in the in-itself? ! Is meaning not necessarily relative meaning and perspective? All meaning is will to

power (all relative meaning resolves itself into it). 591 (1885) The desire for “solid facts”—epistemology: how much pessimism there is in it! 592 (1883-1888) The antagonism between the “true world,” as revealed by pessimism, and a world possible for life—here one must test the rights of truth. It is necessary to measure the meaning of all these “ideal drives” against life to grasp what this antagonism really is: the struggle of sickly, despairing life that cleaves to a beyond, with healthier, more stupid and mendacious, richer, less degenerate life. Therefore it is not “truth” in struggle with life but one kind of life in struggle with another.— But it wants to be the higher kind!— Here one must demonstrate the need for an order of rank—that the first problem is the order of rank of different kinds of life. 593 (1885-1886) To transform the belief “it is thus and thus” into the will “it shall become thus and thus.” 594 (1883-1888) Science—this has been hitherto a way of putting an end to the complete confusion in which things exist, by hypotheses that “explain” everything—so it has come from the intellect’s dislike of chaos.— This same dislike seizes me when I consider myself: I should like to form an image of the inner world, too, by means of some schema, and thus triumph over intellectual confusion. Morality has been a simplification of this kind: it taught that men were known, familiar.— Now we have destroyed morality—we have again become completely obscure to ourselves! I know that I know nothing of myself. Physics proves to be a boon for the heart: science (as the way to knowledge) acquires a new charm after morality has been eliminated—and because it is here alone that we find consistency, we have to construct our life so as to preserve it. This yields a sort of practical reflection on the conditions of our existence as men of knowledge. 595 (1884) Our presuppositions: no God: no purpose: finite force. Let us guard against thinking out and prescribing the mode of thought necessary to lesser men! ! 596 (1886-1887) No “moral education” of the human race: but an enforced schooling in [scientific]44 errors is needed, because “truth” disgusts and makes one sick of life—unless man is already irrevocably launched upon his path and has taken his honest insight upon himself with a tragic pride. 597 (1886-1887) The presupposition of scientific work: belief in the unity and perpetuity of scientific work, so the individual may work at any part, however small, confident that his work will not be in vain. There is one great paralysis: to work in vain, to struggle in vain.— * The accumulative epochs, in which force and means of power are discovered that the future will one day make use of; science an intermediary station, at which the more intermediary, more multifarious, more complicated natures find their most natural discharge and satisfaction—all those who should avoid action.

598 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

A philosopher recuperates differently and with different means: he recuperates, e.g., with nihilism. Belief that there is no truth at all, the nihilistic belief, is a great relaxation for one who, as a warrior of knowledge, is ceaselessly fighting ugly truths. For truth is ugly.⁴⁵ 599 (1885-1886) The “meaninglessness of events”: belief in this is the consequence of an insight into the falsity of previous interpretations, a generalization of discouragement and weakness—not a necessary belief. The immodesty of man: to deny meaning where he sees none. 600 (1885-1886) No limit to the ways in which the world can be interpreted; every interpretation a symptom of growth or of decline. Inertia needs unity (monism); plurality of interpretations a sign of strength. Not to desire to deprive the world of its disturbing and enigmatic character! 601 (1885-1886) Against peaceableness and the desire for reconciliation.⁴⁶ The attempt at monism belongs here. 602 (1884) This perspective world, this world for the eye, tongue, and ear, is very false, even if compared for a very much more subtle sense-apparatus. But its intelligibility, comprehensibility, practicability, and beauty begin to cease if we refine our senses; just as beauty ceases when we think about historical processes; the order of purpose is already an illusion. It suffices that the more superficially and coarsely it is conceived, the more valuable, definite, beautiful, and significant the world appears. The deeper one looks, the more our valuations disappear—meaninglessness approaches! We have created the world that possesses values! Knowing this, we know, too, that reverence for truth is already the consequence of an illusion—and that one should value more than truth the force that forms, simplifies, shapes, invents. “Everything is false! Everything is permitted!” Only with a certain obtuseness of vision, a will to simplicity, does the beautiful, the “valuable” appear: in itself, it is I know not what. 603 (1885) That the destruction of an illusion does not produce truth but only one more piece of ignorance, an extension of our “empty space,” an increase of our “desert”⁴⁸— 604⁴⁹ (1885-1886) “Interpretation,” the introduction of meaning—not “explanation” (in most cases a new interpretation over an old interpretation that has become incomprehensible, that is now itself only a sign). There are no facts, everything is in flux, incomprehensible, elusive; what is relatively most enduring is—our opinions.

605 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The ascertaining of “truth” and “untruth,” the ascertaining of facts in general, is fundamentally different from creative positing, from forming, shaping, overcoming, willing, such as is of the essence of philosophy. To introduce a meaning—this task still remains to be done, assuming there is no meaning yet. Thus it is with sounds, but also with the fate of peoples: they are capable of the most different interpretations and direction toward different goals. On a yet higher level is to posit a goal and mold facts according to it; that is, active interpretation and not merely conceptual translation, 606 (1885-1886)

Ultimately, man finds in things nothing but what he himself has imported into them: the finding is called science, the importing—art, religion, love, pride. Even if this should be a piece of childishness, one should carry on with both and be well disposed toward both—some should find; others—we others!—should import!

607 (Spring-Fall 1886)

Science: its two sides: in regard to the individual; in regard to the cultural complex (level); —valuations from one side or the other are mutually antagonistic. 608 (1886-1887) The development of science resolves the “familiar” more and more into the unfamiliar:—it desires, however, the reverse, and proceeds from the instinct to trace the unfamiliar back to the familiar. In summa, science is preparing a sovereign ignorance, a feeling that there is no such thing as “knowing,” that it was a kind of arrogance to dream of it, more, that we no longer have the least notion that warrants our considering “knowledge” even a possibility—that “knowing” itself is a contradictory idea. We translate a primeval mythology and vanity of mankind into the hard fact: “knowledge-in-itself” is as impermissible a concept as is “thing-in-itself,” Seduction by “number and logic,” seduction by “laws.” “Wisdom” as the attempt to get beyond perspective valuations (i.e., beyond the “will to power”): a principle hostile to life and decadent, a symptom as among the Indians, etc., of the weakening of the power of appropriation. 609 (1884) It is not enough that you understand in what ignorance man and beast live; you must also have and acquire the will to ignorance. You need to grasp that without this kind of ignorance life itself would be impossible, that it is a condition under which alone the living thing can preserve itself and prosper: a great, firm dome of ignorance must encompass you. 610 (1884) Science—the transformation of nature into concepts for the purpose of mastering nature—belongs under the rubric “means.” But the purpose and will of man must grow in the same way, the intention in regard to the whole. 611 (1883-1888) We find that the strongest and most constantly employed faculty at all stages of life is thought—even in every act of perceiving and apparent passivity! Evidently, it thus becomes most powerful and demanding, and in the long run it tyrannizes over all other forces. Finally it becomes “passion-in-itself.”

612 (Spring-Fall 1887)

To win back for the man of knowledge the right to great affects! after self-effacement and the cult of “objectivity” have created a false order of rank in this sphere, too. Error reached its peak when Schopenhauer taught: the only way to the “true,” to knowledge, lies precisely in getting free from affects, from will; the intellect liberated from will cannot but see the true, real essence of things. The same error in arte:50 as if everything were beautiful as soon as it is viewed without will.

613 (Fall 1888)

Competition between affects and the dominion of one of the affects over the intellect. 614 (1884) To “humanize” the world, i.e., to feel ourselves more and more masters within it— 615 (1884) Among a higher kind of creatures, knowledge, too, will acquire new forms that are not yet needed. 616 (1885-1886) That the value of the world lies in our interpretation (—that other interpretations than merely human ones are perhaps somewhere possible—); that previous interpretations have been perspective valuations by virtue of which we can survive in life, i.e., in the will to power, for the growth of power; that every elevation of man brings with it the overcoming of narrower interpretations; that every strengthening and increase of power opens up new perspectives and means believing in new horizons—this idea permeates my writings. The world with which we are concerned is false, i.e., is not a fact but a fable and approximation on the basis of a meager sum of observations; it is “in flux,” as something in a state of becoming, as a falsehood always changing but never getting near the truth: for—there is no “truth.” 617 (1883-1885)⁵¹ To impose upon becoming the character of being—that is the supreme will to power. Twofold falsification, on the part of the senses and of the spirit, to preserve a world of that which is, which abides, which is equivalent, etc. That everything recurs is the closest approximation of a world of becoming to a world of being:—high point of the meditation. From the values attributed to being proceed the condemnation of and discontent with becoming, after such a world of being had first been invented. The metamorphoses of what has being (body, God, ideas, laws of nature, formulas, etc.) “Beings” as appearance; reversal of values; appearance was that which conferred value—. Knowledge-in-itself in a world of becoming is impossible; so how is knowledge possible? As error concerning oneself, as will to power, as will to deception. Becoming as invention, willing, self-denial, overcoming of oneself: no subject but an action, a positing, creative, no “causes and effects.” Art as the will to overcome becoming, as “eternalization,” but shortsighted, depending on the perspective: repeating in miniature, as it were, the tendency of the whole. Regarding that which all life reveals as a diminutive formula for the total tendency; hence a new definition of the concept “life” as will to power. Instead of “cause and effect” the mutual struggle of that which becomes, often with the absorption of one’s opponent; the number of becoming elements not constant. Uselessness of old ideals for the interpretation of the totality of events, once one knows the animal origin and utility of these ideals; all, moreover, contradictory to life. Uselessness of the mechanistic theory—it gives the impression of meaninglessness. The entire idealism of mankind hitherto is on the point of changing suddenly into nihilism—into the belief in absolute worthlessness, i.e., meaninglessness. The destruction of ideals, the new desert;

new arts by means of which we can endure it, we amphibians. Presupposition: bravery, patience, no “turning back,” no haste to go forward. (N B. Zarathustra adopts a parodistic attitude toward all former values as a consequence of his abundance.) 8 MS: bedingt (conditioned); printed versions: bedingende (conditioning). The editors took their cue from Kant, not from Nietzsche’s next sentence. 13 MS not in Nietzsche’s hand; evidently dictated. 14 I say. 37 “Rule”: uncertain reading 38 “Madness”: very doubtful conjecture; in the original, two illegible words. Cf. the chapter “On War and Warriors” in Zarathustra, I (Portable Nietzsche, p. 158 ff). And note the deliberate antithesis, especially of the formulation in the text, to the romantic identification of truth and beauty. The quotation comprising the next paragraph should be compared with “Nothing is true, everything is permitted,” in Genealogy III, section 24; see also my notes on that section. 52 A reference to Nietzsche’s doctrine of the eternal recurrence of the same events. Cf. sections 55 and 1,057 ff. II. THE WILL TO POWER IN NATURE 618 (1885) Of all the interpretations of the world attempted hitherto, the mechanistic one seems today to stand victorious in the foreground. It evidently has a good conscience on its side; and no science believes it can achieve progress and success except with the aid of mechanistic procedures. Everyone knows these procedures: one leaves “reason” and “purpose” out of account as far as possible, one shows that, given sufficient time, anything can evolve out of anything else, and one does not conceal a malicious chuckle when “apparent intention” in the fate of a plant or an egg yolk is once again traced back to pressure and stress: in short, one pays heartfelt homage to the principle of the greatest possible stupidity, if a playful expression may be allowed concerning such serious matters. Meanwhile, a presentiment, or anxiety, is to be noted among select spirits involved in this movement, as if the theory had a hole in it that might sooner or later prove to be its final hole: I mean the shrill one through which one whistles in an extreme emergency.⁵⁵ One cannot “explain” pressure and stress themselves, one cannot get free of the *actio in distans*:⁵⁶—one has lost the belief in being able to explain at all, and admits with a wry expression that description and not explanation is all that is possible, that the dynamic interpretation of the world, with its denial of “empty space” and its little clumps of atoms, will shortly come to dominate physicists; though an inner quality in dynamis—— 619 (1885) The victorious concept “force,” by means of which our physicists have created God and the world, still needs to be completed: an inner will must be ascribed to it, which I designate as “will to power,” i.e., as an insatiable desire to manifest power; or as the employment and exercise of power, as a creative drive, etc. Physicists cannot eradicate “action at a distance” from their principles; nor can they eradicate a repellent force (or an attracting one). There is nothing for it: one is obliged to understand all motion, all “appearances,” all “laws,” only as symptoms of an inner event and to employ

man as an analogy to this end. In the case of an animal, it is possible to trace all its drives to the will to power; likewise all the functions of organic life to this one source. 620 (1885-1886) Has a force ever been demonstrated? No, only effects translated into a completely foreign language. We are so used, however, to regularity in succession that its oddity no longer seems odd to us. 621 (1885-1886) A force we cannot imagine is an empty word and should be allowed no rights of citizenship in science; like the so-called purely mechanistic forces of attraction and repulsion, which are intended to make it possible for us to form an image of the world, no more! 622 (1885-1886) Pressure and stress, something unspeakably late, derivative, un-primeval. For they presuppose something that holds together and is able to exert pressure and stress! But how can it hold together?

623 (March-June 1888)

There is nothing unchanging in chemistry: this is only appearance, a mere school prejudice. We have slipped in the unchanging, my physicist friends, deriving it from metaphysics as always. To assert that diamond, graphite, and carbon are identical is to read off the facts naively from the surface. Why? Merely because no loss in substance can be shown on the scales! Very well, they have something in common; but the activity of molecules during the transformation, which we cannot see or weigh, turns one material into something different—with specifically different properties. 624 (1883-1888) Against the physical atom.—To comprehend the world, we have to be able to calculate it; to be able to calculate it, we have to have constant causes; because we find no such constant causes in actuality, we invent them for ourselves—the atoms. This is the origin of atomism. The calculability of the world, the expressibility of all events in formulas—is this really “comprehension”? How much of a piece of music has been understood when that in it which is calculable and can be reduced to formulas has been reckoned up?— And “constant causes,” things, substances, something “unconditioned”; invented—what has one achieved?

625 (March-June 1888)

The mechanistic concept of “motion” is already a translation of the original process into the sign language of sight and touch. The concept “atom,” the distinction between the “‘seat of a driving force and the force itself,” is a sign language derived from our logical-psychical world. We cannot change our means of expression at will: it is possible to understand to what extent they are mere signs. The demand for an adequate mode of expression is senseless: it is of the essence of a language, a means of expression, to express a mere relationship—The concept “truth” is nonsensical. The entire domain of “true-false” applies only to relations, not to an “in-itself”—There is no “essence-in-itself” (it is only relations that constitute an essence—), just as there can be no “knowledge-in-itself.” 626 (1883-1886) “The sensation of force cannot proceed from motion: sensation in general cannot proceed from motion.” “It is only an apparent experience that speaks in favor of this: in a substance (brain), sensations are produced by transmitted motion (stimuli). But produced? Would this prove that the sensation did not exist there at all? so that its appearance would have to be conceived as a creative act on the part of the motion? The sensationless state of this substance is only a hypothesis! it is not experienced!—Sensation is thus a property of substance: there are substances that have sensations.” “Do we discover from certain substances that they have no sensations? No, we only fail to discover that they have any. It is impossible to derive sensation from a substance without sensation.”—Oh what overhastiness! 627 (1885-1886) “Attraction” and “repulsion” in a purely mechanistic sense are complete fictions: a word. We cannot think of an attraction divorced from an intention.—The will to take possession of a thing or to defend oneself against it and repel it—that, we “understand”: that would be an interpretation of which we could make use. In short: the psychological necessity for a belief in causality lies in the inconceivability of an event divorced from intent; by which naturally nothing is said concerning truth or untruth (the justification of such a belief)! The belief in *causae* falls with the belief in *téle* (against Spinoza and his causalism). 628 (1885-1886) It is an illusion that something is known when we possess a mathematical formula for an event: it is only designated, described; nothing more! 629 (1883-1888) If I reduce a regular event to a formula, I have foreshortened, facilitated, etc., the description of the whole phenomenon. But I have established no “law,” I have raised the question how it happens that something here repeats itself: that the formula corresponds to a complex of initially unknown forces and discharges of force, is a supposition; it is mythology to think that forces here obey a law, so that, as a consequence of their obedience, we have the same phenomenon each time. 630 (1885) I beware of speaking of chemical “laws”: that savors of morality. It is far rather a question of the absolute

establishment of power relationships: the stronger becomes master of the weaker, in so far as the latter cannot assert its degree of independence— here there is no mercy, no forbearance, even less a respect for “laws”! 631 (1885-1886) The unalterable sequence of certain phenomena demonstrates no “law” but a power relationship between two or more forces. To say “But this relationship itself remains constant” is to say no more than “One and the same force cannot also be another force.”— It is a question, not of succession, but of interpenetration, a process in which the individual successive moments are not related to one another as cause and effect— The separation of the “deed” from the “doer,” of the event from someone who produces events, of the process from a something that is not process but enduring, substance, thing, body, soul, etc.—the attempt to comprehend an event as a sort of shifting and place-changing on the part of a “being,” of something constant: this ancient mythology established the belief in “cause and effect” after it had found a firm form in the functions of language and grammar 632 (1885-1886) “Regularity” in succession is only a metaphorical expression, as if a rule were being followed here; not a fact. In the same way “conformity with a law.” We discover a formula by which to express an ever-recurring kind of result: we have therewith discovered no “law,” even less a force that is the cause of the recurrence of a succession of results. That something always happens thus and thus is here interpreted as if a creature always acted thus and thus as a result of obedience to a law or a lawgiver, while it would be free to act otherwise were it not for the “law.” But precisely this thus-and-not-otherwise might be inherent in the creature, which might behave thus and thus, not in response to a law, but because it is constituted thus and thus. All it would mean is: something cannot also be something else, cannot do now this and now something else, is neither free nor unfree but simply thus and thus. The mistake lies in the fictitious insertion of a subject.

633 (March-June 1888)

Two successive states, the one “cause,” the other “effect”: this is false. The first has nothing to effect, the second has been effected by nothing. It is a question of a struggle between two elements of unequal power: a new arrangement of forces is achieved according to the measure of power of each of them. The second condition is something fundamentally different from the first (not its effect): the essential thing is that the factions in struggle emerge with different quanta of power.

634 (March-June 1888)

Critique of the mechanistic theory.— Let us here dismiss the two popular concepts “necessity” and “law”: the former introduces a false constraint into the world, the latter a false freedom. “Things” do not behave regularly, according to a rule: there are no things (—they are fictions invented by us); they behave just as little under the constraint of necessity. There is no obedience here: for that something is as it is, as strong or as weak, is not the consequence of an obedience or a rule or a compulsion— The degree of resistance and the degree of superior power— this is the question in every event: if, for our day-to-day calculations, we know how to express this in formulas and “laws,” so much the better for us! But we have not introduced any “morality” into the world by the fiction that it is obedient—. There is no law: every power draws its ultimate consequence at every moment. Calculability exists precisely because things are unable to be other than they are. A quantum of power is designated by the effect it produces and that which it resists. The adaphorous state is missing, though it is thinkable. It is essentially a will to violate and to defend oneself against violation. Not self-preservation: every atom affects the whole of being—it is thought away if one thinks away this radiation of power-will. That is why I call it a quantum of “will to power”: it expresses the characteristic that cannot be thought out of the mechanistic order without thinking away this order itself. A translation of this world of effect into a visible world—a world for the eyes—is the conception “motion.” This always carries the idea that something is moved—this always supposes, whether as the fiction of a little clump of atom or even as the abstraction of this, the dynamic atom, a thing that produces effects—i.e., we have not got away from the habit into which our senses and language seduce us. Subject, object, a doer added to the doing, the doing separated from that which it does: let us not forget that this is mere semeiotics and nothing real. Mechanistic theory as a theory of motion is already a translation into the sense language of man.⁵⁹

635 (March-June 1888)

We need “unities” in order to be able to reckon: that does not mean we must suppose that such unities exist. We have borrowed the concept of unity from our “ego” concept—our oldest article of faith. If we did not hold ourselves to be unities, we would never have formed the concept “thing.” Now, somewhat late, we are firmly convinced that our conception of the ego does not guarantee any actual unity. In order to sustain the theory of a mechanistic world, therefore, we always have to stipulate to what extent we are employing two fictions: the concept of motion (taken from our sense language) and the concept of the atom (= unity, deriving from our psychical “experience”): the mechanistic theory presupposes a sense prejudice and a psychological prejudice. Mechanistic theory formulates consecutive appearances, and it does so semeiotically, in terms of the senses and of psychology (that all effect is motion; that where there is motion something is moved); it does not touch upon the causal force. The mechanistic world is imagined as only sight and touch imagine a world (as “moved”)—so as to be calculable—thus causal unities are invented, “things” (atoms) whose effect remains constant (—transference of the false concept of subject to the concept of the atom). The following are therefore phenomenal: the injection of the concept of number, the concept of the thing (concept of the subject), the concept of activity (separation of cause from effect), the concept of motion (sight and touch) : our eye and our psychology are still part of it. If we eliminate these additions, no things remain but only dynamic quanta, in a relation of tension to all other dynamic quanta: their essence lies in their relation to all other quanta, in their “effect” upon the same. The will to power not a being, not a becoming, but a pathos—the most elemental fact from which a becoming and effecting first emerge—

636 (March-June 1888)

Physicists believe in a “true world” in their own fashion: a firm systematization of atoms in necessary motion, the same for all beings—so for them the “apparent world” is reduced to the side of universal and universally necessary being which is accessible to every being in its own way (accessible and also already adapted — made “subjective”). But they are in error. The atom they posit is inferred according to the logic of the perspectivism of consciousness—and is therefore itself a subjective fiction. This world picture that they sketch differs in no essential way from the subjective world picture: it is only construed with more extended senses, but with our senses nonetheless— And in any case they left something out of the constellation without knowing it: precisely this necessary perspectivism by virtue of which every center of force—and not only man—construes all the rest of the world from its own viewpoint, i.e., measures, feels, forms, according to its own force— They forgot to include this perspective-setting force in “true being”—in school language: the subject. They think this is “evolved,” added later; but even the chemist needs it: it is being specific, definitely acting and reacting thus and thus, as may be the case. Perspectivism is only a complex form of specificity. My idea is that every specific body strives to become master over all space and to extend its force (—its will to power;) and to thrust back all that resists its extension. But it continually encounters similar efforts on the part of other bodies and ends by coming to an arrangement (“union”) with those of them that are sufficiently related to it: thus they then conspire together for power. And the process goes on— 637 (1885) Even in the domain of the inorganic an atom of force is concerned only with its neighborhood: distant forces balance one another. Here is the kernel of the perspective view and why a living creature is “egoistic” through and through. 638 (1885-1886) Supposing that the world had a certain quantum of force at its disposal, then it is obvious that every displacement of power at any point would affect the whole system—thus together with sequential causality there would be a contiguous and concurrent dependence.

639 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The sole way of maintaining a meaning for the concept “God” would be: God not as the driving force, but God as a maximal state, as an epoch—a point in the evolution of the will to power by means of which further evolution just as much as previous evolution up to him could be explained. Regarded mechanistically, the energy of the totality of becoming remains constant; regarded economically, it rises to a high point and sinks down again in an eternal circle. This “will to power” expresses itself in the interpretation, in the manner in which force is used up; transformation of energy into life, and “life at its highest potency,” thus appears as the goal. The same quantum of energy means different things at different stages of evolution. That which constitutes growth in life is an ever more thrifty and more far-seeing economy, which achieves more and more with less and less force— As an ideal, the principle of the smallest expenditure— That the world is not striving toward a stable condition is the only thing that has been proved. Consequently one must conceive its climactic condition in such a way that it is not a condition of equilibrium— The absolute necessity of similar events occurring in the course of one world, as in all others, is in eternity not a determinism ruling events, but merely the expression of the fact that the impossible is not possible; that a certain force cannot be anything other than this certain force; that it can react to a quantum of resisting force only according to the measure of its strength;— event and necessary event is a tautology. A. The Organic Process 640 (1883-1888) Man thinks of himself as having been present when the organic world originated: what was there to be perceived by sight and touch when this event took place? What can be reduced to figures? What laws are revealed in the motions? Thus: man wants to arrange all events as events accessible to sight and touch, consequently as motions: he wants to find formulas so as to simplify the tremendous quantity of his experiences. Reduction of all events to the level of the man of the senses and the mathematician. It is a question of an inventory of human experiences—under the supposition that man, or rather the human eye and ability to form concepts, are the eternal witness of all things. 641 (1883-1888) A multiplicity of forces, connected by a common mode of nutrition, we call “life.” To this mode of nutrition, as a means of making it possible, belong all so-called feelings, ideas, thoughts; i.e., (1) a resistance to all other forces; (2) an adjustment of the same according to form and rhythm; (3) an estimate in regard to assimilation or excretion. 642 (1885) The connection between the inorganic and the organic must lie in the repelling force exercised by every atom of force. “Life” would be defined as an enduring form of processes of the establishment of force, in which the different contenders grow unequally. To what extent resistance is present even in obedience; individual power is by no means surrendered. In the same way, there is in commanding an admission that

the absolute power of the opponent has not been vanquished, incorporated, disintegrated. “Obedience” and “commanding” are forms of struggle. 643 (1885-1886) The will to power interprets (—it is a question of interpretation when an organ is constructed): it defines limits, determines degrees, variations of power. Mere variations of power could not feel themselves to be such: there must be present something that wants to grow and interprets the value of whatever else wants to grow. Equal in that— In fact, interpretation is itself a means of becoming master of something (The organic process constantly presupposes interpretations.) 644 (1883-1888) Greater complexity, sharp differentiation, the contiguity of developed organs and functions with the disappearance of the intermediate members—if that is perfection, then there is a will to power in the organic process by virtue of which dominant, shaping, commanding forces continually extend the bounds of their power and continually simplify within these bounds: the imperative grows. “Spirit” is only a means and tool in the service of higher life, of the enhancement of life; and as for the good, as Plato (and after him Christianity) understood it, it seems to me to be actually a life-endangering, life-calumniating, life-denying principle. 645 (1885) That “heredity,” as something quite unexplained, cannot be employed as an explanation but only to describe and fix a problem. The same applies to “power of adaptation.” Indeed, the morphological presentation, even if it were complete, explains nothing, but only describes a tremendous fact. How an organ can be employed to achieve something is not explained. In these matters, the assumption of *causae finales* explains as little as the assumption of *causae efficientes*. The concept of “*causa*” is only a means of expression, nothing more; a means of description. 646 (7555) There are analogies; e.g., a memory analogous to our memory that reveals itself in heredity and evolution and forms. An inventiveness in the application of tools to new ends analogous to our inventiveness and experimentation, etc. That which we call our “consciousness” is innocent of any of the essential processes of our preservation and our growth; and no head is so subtle that it could construe more than a machine—to which every organic process is far superior. 647 (1883-1888) Against Darwinism— The utility of an organ does not explain its origin; on the contrary! For most of the time during which a property is forming it does not preserve the individual and is of no use to him, least of all in the struggle with external circumstances and enemies. What, after all, is “useful”? One must ask “useful in relation to what?” E.g., that which is useful for the long life of the individual might be unfavorable to its strength and splendor; that which preserves the individual might at the same time arrest and halt its evolution On the other hand, a deficiency, a degeneration, can be of the highest utility in so far as it acts as a stimulant to other organs. In the same way, a state of need can be a condition of existence, in so far as it reduces an individual to that measure of expenditure which holds it together but prevents it

from squandering itself.— The individual itself as a struggle between parts (for food, space, etc.) : its evolution tied to the victory or predominance of individual parts, to an atrophy, a “becoming an organ” of other parts. The influence of “external circumstances” is overestimated by Darwin to a ridiculous extent: the essential thing in the life process is precisely the tremendous shaping, form-creating force working from within which utilizes and exploits “external circumstances”— The new forms molded from within are not formed with an end in view; but in the struggle of the parts a new form is not left long without being related to a partial usefulness and then, according to its use, develops itself more and more completely.62 648 (1883-1888) “Useful” in respect of acceleration of the tempo of evolution is a different kind of “useful” from that in respect of the greatest possible stability and durability of that which is evolved. 649 (1883-1888) “Useful” in the sense of Darwinist biology means: proved advantageous in the struggle with others. But it seems to me that the feeling of increase, the feeling of becoming stronger, is itself, quite apart from any usefulness in the struggle, the real progress: only from this feeling does there arise the will to struggle— 650 (1885-1886) Physiologists should think again before positing the “instinct of preservation” as the cardinal drive in an organic creature. A living thing wants above all to discharge its force: “preservation” is only a consequence of this.— Beware of superfluous teleological principles! The entire concept “instinct of preservation” is one of them.

651 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

One cannot ascribe the most basic and primeval activities of protoplasm to a will to self-preservation, for it takes into itself absurdly more than would be required to preserve it; and, above all, it does not thereby “preserve itself,” it falls apart—The drive that rules here has to explain precisely this absence of desire for self-preservation: “hunger” is an interpretation based on far more complicated organisms (—hunger is a specialized and later form of the drive, an expression of a division of labor in the service of a higher drive that rules over it).

652 (March-June 1888)

It is not possible to take hunger as the *primum mobile*,⁶³ any more than self-preservation. To understand hunger as a consequence of undernourishment means: hunger as the consequence of a will to power that no longer achieves mastery. It is by no means a question of replacing a loss—only later, as a result of the division of labor, after the will to power has learned to take other roads to its satisfaction, is an organism's need to appropriate reduced to hunger, to the need to replace what has been lost.

653 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The false “altruism” of biologists is ridiculous: propagation among amoebas seems to be the throwing off of ballast, a pure advantage. The excretion of useless material. 654 (1885-1886) A protoplasm divides in two when its power is no longer adequate to control what it has appropriated: procreation is the consequence of an impotency. When, from hunger, the males seek out the females and are united with them, procreation is the consequence of a hunger. 655 (1885) The weaker presses to the stronger from a need for nourishment; it wants to get under it, if possible to become one with it. The stronger, on the contrary, drives others away; it does not want to perish in this manner; it grows and in growing it splits itself into two or more parts. The greater the impulse toward unity, the more firmly may one conclude that weakness is present; the greater the impulse towards variety, differentiation, inner decay, the more force is present. The drive to approach—and the drive to thrust something back are the bond, in both the inorganic and the organic world. The entire distinction is a prejudice. The will to power in every combination of forces, defending itself against the stronger, lunging at the weaker, is more correct. N.B.: Processes as “entities.”⁶⁴

656 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The will to power can manifest itself only against resistances; therefore it seeks that which resists it—this is the primeval tendency of the protoplasm when it extends pseudopodia and feels about. Appropriation and assimilation are above all a desire to overwhelm, a forming, shaping and reshaping, until at length that which has been overwhelmed has entirely gone over into the power domain of the aggressor and has increased the same.— If this incorporation is not successful, then the form probably falls to pieces; and the duality appears as a consequence of the will to power: in order not to let go what has been conquered, the will to power divides itself into two wills (in some cases without completely surrendering the connection between its two parts). “Hunger” is only a narrower adaptation after the basic drive for power has won a more spiritual form. 657 (1886-1887) What is “passive”?— To be hindered from moving forward: thus an act of resistance and reaction. What is “active”?—reaching out for power. “Nourishment”—is only derivative; the original phenomenon is: to desire to incorporate everything. “Procreation”—only derivative; originally: where one will was not enough to organize the entire appropriated material, there came into force an opposing will which took in hand the separation; a new center of organization, after a struggle with the original will. “Pleasure”—as a feeling of power (presupposing displeasure). 658 (1885) The organic functions translated back to the basic will, the will to power—and understood as offshoots. The will to power specializes as will to nourishment, to property, to tools, to servants (those who obey) and masters: the body as an example.— The stronger will directs the weaker. There is absolutely no other kind of causality than that of will upon will. Not explained mechanistically. Thinking, feeling, willing in all living beings. What is a pleasure but: an excitation of the feeling of power by an obstacle (even more strongly by rhythmic obstacles and resistances)—so it swells up. Thus all pleasure includes pain.— If the pleasure is to be very great, the pains must be very protracted and the tension of the bow tremendous. The spiritual functions. Will to shape, to assimilate, etc. B. Man 659 (1885) The evidence of the body.— Granted that the “soul” is an attractive and mysterious idea which philosophers have rightly abandoned only with reluctance—perhaps that which they have since learned to put in its place is even more attractive, even more mysterious. The human body, in which the most distant and most recent past of all organic development again becomes living and corporeal, through which and over and beyond which a tremendous inaudible stream seems to flow: the body is a more astonishing idea than the old “soul.” In all ages, there has been more faith in the body, as our most personal possession, our most certain being, in short our ego, than in the spirit (or the “soul,” or the subject, as school language now has it instead of soul). It has never occurred to anyone to

regard his stomach as a strange or, say, a divine stomach: but to conceive his ideas as “inspired,” his evaluations as “implanted by a God,” his instincts as activity in a half-light—for this tendency and taste in men there are witnesses from all ages of mankind. Even now there is ample evidence among artists of a sort of wonderment and respectful suspension of judgment when they are faced with the question of the means by which they achieved their best work and from which world the creative idea came to them; when they ask this, they exhibit some-think like innocence and childlike shamefacedness; they hardly dare to say “it came from me, it was my hand that threw the dice.” Conversely, even those philosophers and religious teachers who had the most compelling ground in their logic and piety to consider their bodies a deception (and, indeed, as a deception overcome and done with) could not help acknowledging the foolish fact that the body has not gone away; of which the strangest witnesses are to be found partly in Paul, partly in the Vedanta philosophy. But what, after all, does strength of belief mean? It could still be a very foolish belief!— This should be reflected on: — And after all, if belief in the body is only the result of an inference: supposing it were a false inference, as the idealists assert, is it not a question mark against the spirit itself that it should be the cause of such false inferences? Supposing multiplicity, space and time, and motion (and whatever else may be the presuppositions of a belief in what is bodily) were errors—what mistrust would this arouse against the spirit that had prompted such presuppositions? Let it suffice that, for the present, belief in the body is always a stronger belief than belief in the spirit; and whoever desires to undermine it, also undermines at the same time most thoroughly belief in the authority of the spirit! 660 (1885-1886)

The Body as a Political Structure. The aristocracy in the body, the majority of the rulers (struggle between cells and tissues). Slavery and division of labor: the higher type possible only through the subjugation of the lower, so that it becomes a function. Pleasure and pain not opposites. The feeling of power. “Nourishment” only a consequence of insatiable appropriation, of the will to power. “Procreation,” the crumbling that supervenes when the ruling cells are incapable of organizing that which has been appropriated. It is the shaping force that desires an ever new supply of “material” (more “force”). The masterpiece of the construction of an organism from an egg. “Mechanistic interpretation”: desires nothing but quantities; but force is to be found in quality. Mechanistic theory can therefore only describe processes, not explain them. “Purpose.” One should start from the “sagacity” of plants. Concept of “perfecting”: not only greater complexity, but greater power (—does not have to be merely greater mass—). Inference concerning the evolution of mankind: perfecting consists in the production of the most powerful individuals, who will use the great mass of people as their tools (and indeed the most intelligent and most pliable tools). 661 (1883-1888) Why is all activity, even that of a sense, associated with pleasure?

Because before it an obstacle, a burden existed? Or rather because all doing is an overcoming, a becoming master, and increases the feeling of power?— Pleasure in thinking.— Ultimately, it is not only the feeling of power, but the pleasure in creating and in the thing created; for all activity enters our consciousness as consciousness of a “work.” 662 (1883-1888) Creation—as selection and finishing of the thing selected. (This is the essential thing in every act of will.) 663 (1885-1886) All events that result from intention are reducible to the intention to increase power. 664 (1883-1888) When we do something there arises a feeling of force,⁶⁵ often even before the deed, occasioned by the idea of what is to be done (as at the sight of an enemy or an obstacle to which we feel ourselves equal): it is always an accompanying feeling. We instinctively think that this feeling of force is the cause of the action, that it is “the force.” Our belief in causality is belief in force and its effect; a transference from our experience; and we identify force and the feeling of force.— Force, however, never moves things; the force we feel “does not set the muscles in motion.” “We have no idea, no experience, of such a process.”— “Just as we have no experience of force as the cause of motion, so we have no experience of the necessity of any motion.” Force is supposed to be that which compels! “We experience only that one thing follows upon another.— We have no experience of either compulsion or arbitrariness in the following of one thing upon another.” Causality is created only by thinking compulsion into the process. A certain “comprehension” is the consequence, i.e., we have made the process more human, “more familiar”: the familiar is the familiar habit of human compulsion associated with the feeling of force. 665 (1883-1888) I have the intention of raising my arm: supposing I know as little of the physiology of the human body and the mechanical laws of its motion as the man in the street, what could really be more vague, pale, uncertain than this intention, when compared with what follows upon it? And suppose I am the most astute of mechanics and specially instructed in the formulas applicable here, I should not be able to raise my arm one whit the better or the worse. Our “knowledge” and our “deed” lie in this case coldly apart, as if in two different domains.— On the other hand: Napoleon executed a plan of campaign—what does that mean? Here everything pertaining to the execution of the plan is known, because everything has to be transmitted by command; but here, too, subordinates are presupposed who interpret and apply the general plan to the needs of the moment, measure of force, etc. 666 (1883-1888) From time immemorial we have ascribed the value of an action, a character, an existence, to the intention, the purpose for the sake of which one has acted or lived: this age-old idiosyncrasy finally takes a dangerous turn— provided, that is, that the absence of intention and purpose in events comes more and more to the forefront of consciousness. Thus there seems to be in preparation a universal disvaluation: “Nothing has any meaning”—this melancholy sentence

means “All meaning lies in intention, and if intention is altogether lacking, then meaning is altogether lacking, too.” In accordance with this valuation, one was constrained to transfer the value of life to a “life after death,” or to the progressive development of ideas or of mankind or of the people or beyond mankind; but with that one had arrived at a progressus in infinitum of purposes: one was at last constrained to make a place for oneself in the “world process” (perhaps with the dysdaemonistic perspective that it was a process into nothingness). In this regard, “purpose” requires a more vigorous critique: one must understand that an action is never caused by a purpose; that purpose and means are interpretations whereby certain points in an event are emphasized and selected at the expense of other points, which, indeed, form the majority; that every single time something is done with a purpose in view, something fundamentally different and other occurs; that every purposive action is like the supposed purposiveness of the heat the sun gives off: the enormously greater part is squandered; a part hardly worth considering serves a “purpose,” has “meaning”; that a “purpose” and its “means” provide an indescribably imprecise description, which can, indeed, issue commands as a prescription, as a “will,” but which presupposes a system of obedient and trained tools, which in place of indefinite entities posit nothing but fixed magnitudes (i.e., we imagine a system of shrewder but narrower intellects that posit purposes and means, in order to be able to ascribe to our only known “purpose” the role of the “cause of an action,” to which procedure we really have no right: it would mean solving a problem by placing the solution in a world inaccessible to our observation—). Finally: why could “a purpose” not be an epiphenomenon in the series of changes in the activating forces that bring about the purposive action—a pale image sketched in consciousness beforehand that serves to orient us concerning events, even as a symptom of events, not as their cause?— But with this we have criticized the will itself: is it not an illusion to take for a cause that which rises to consciousness as an act of will? Are not all phenomena of consciousness merely terminal phenomena, final links in a chain, but apparently conditioning one another in their succession on one level of consciousness? This could be an illusion— 667 (1883-1888) Science does not ask what drives us to this will: it rather denies that will is exercised, and holds that something quite different occurs—in short, that the belief in “will” and “purpose” is an illusion. It does not inquire after the motives of an action, as if these had been present in consciousness before the action; but it first breaks up the action into a group of mechanistic phenomena and seeks the previous history of this mechanistic motion—but it does not seek it in feeling, sensation, thinking. It can never take the explanation from this quarter: sensation is precisely the material that is to be explained.— Its problem is: to explain the world without taking sensations as causes; for that would mean: considering sensations as the cause of sensations.

Its task is certainly not accomplished Therefore: either no will—the hypothesis of science—or free will. The latter assumption the dominant feeling from which we cannot get loose, even if the scientific hypothesis were proved true. The popular belief in cause and effect is founded on the presupposition that free will is the cause of every effect: it is only from this that we derive the feeling of causality. Thus there is also in it the feeling that every cause is not an effect but always only a cause—if the will is the cause. “Our acts of will are not necessary”—this idea is contained in the concept “will.” What is necessary is the effect following upon the cause—that is what we feel. That our willing, too, is in every case a compulsion is a hypothesis.

668 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

“Willing” is not “desiring,” striving, demanding; it is distinguished from these by the affect of commanding. There is no such thing as “willing,” but only a willing something: one must not remove the aim from the total condition— as epistemologists do. “Willing” as they understand it is as little a reality as “thinking”: it is a pure fiction. It is part of willing that something is commanded (—which naturally does not mean that the will is “effected”). That state of tension by virtue of which a force seeks to discharge itself—is not an example of “willing.”

669 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

“Displeasure” and “pleasure” are the most stupid means imaginable of expressing judgments: which naturally does not mean that the judgments made audible in this manner must be stupid. The abandonment of all substantiation and logicity, a Yes or No in the reduction to a passionate desire to have or a rejection, an imperative abbreviation whose utility is unmistakable: this is pleasure and displeasure. It originates in the central sphere of the intellect; its presupposition is an infinitely speeded-up perception, ordering, subsumption, calculating, inferring: pleasure and displeasure are always terminal phenomena, not “causes.” The decision about what arouses pleasure and what arouses displeasure depends upon the degree of power: something that in relation to a small quantum of power appears dangerous and seems to require the speediest defense, can evoke, given the consciousness of greater power, a voluptuous excitement and a feeling of pleasure. All feelings of pleasure and displeasure presuppose a calculation of utility and harmfulness to the whole; in other words, a sphere where an end (a state) is desired and means for it are selected. Pleasure and displeasure are never “basic facts.” Feelings of pleasure and displeasure are reactions of the will (affects), in which the intellectual center fixes the value of certain changes which have occurred in relation to the value of the whole; at the same time the introduction of counteractions. 670 (1883-1888) The belief in “affects.”—Affects are a construction of the intellect, an invention of causes that do not exist. All general bodily feelings that we do not understand are interpreted intellectually; i.e., a reason is sought in persons, experiences, etc., for why one feels this way or that. Thus something disadvantageous, dangerous, or strange is posited as the cause of our ill humor; in fact, it is added on to ill humor, in order to render our condition comprehensible. Frequent rushes of blood to the brain accompanied by a choking sensation are interpreted as “anger”: persons and things that rouse us to anger are means of relieving our physiological condition. — Subsequently, after long habituation, certain incidents are so regularly associated with certain general feelings that the sight of certain incidents arouses the corresponding feeling and in particular brings with it this congestion of blood, production of semen, etc., through closeness of association. We then say that “the affect is aroused.” Judgments already inhere in “pleasure” and “displeasure”; stimuli are differentiated according to whether or not they further the feeling of power. The belief in willing. To posit a belief as the cause of a mechanistic motion is to believe in miracles. The consistency of science demands that, once we have made the world thinkable by means of little images, we should also make the affects, desires, will, etc., thinkable, i.e., deny them and treat them as errors of the intellect. 671 (1883-1888) Freedom of will or no freedom of will?—There is no such thing as “will”; it is only a simplifying

conception of understanding, as is “matter.” All actions must first be made possible mechanically before they are willed. Or: the “purpose” usually comes into the mind only after everything has been prepared for its execution. The end is an “inner” “stimulus”—no more. 672 (1883-1888) The most recent history of an action relates to this action; but further back lies a prehistory which covers a wider field: the individual action is at the same time a part of a much more extensive, later fact. The briefer and the more extended processes are not separated— 673 (1883-1888) Theory of chance. The soul a selective and self-nourishing entity, perpetually extremely shrewd and creative (this creative force is usually overlooked! is conceived only as “passive”). To recognize the active force, the creative force in the chance event:—chance itself is only the clash of creative impulses.

674 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

In the tremendous multiplicity of events within an organism, the part which becomes conscious to us is a mere means: and the little bit of “virtue,” “selflessness,” and similar fictions are refuted radically by the total balance of events. We should study our organism in all its immorality— The animal functions are, as a matter of principle, a million times more important than all our beautiful moods and heights of consciousness: the latter are a surplus, except when they have to serve as tools of those animal functions. The entire conscious life, the spirit along with the soul, the heart, goodness, and virtue—in whose service do they labor? In the service of the greatest possible perfection of the means (means of nourishment, means of enhancement) of the basic animal functions: above all, the enhancement of life. What one used to call “body” and “flesh” is of such unspeakably greater importance: the remainder is a small accessory. The task of spinning on the chain of life, and in such a way that the thread grows ever more powerful—that is the task. But consider how heart, soul, virtue, spirit practically conspire together to subvert this systematic task—as if they were the end in view!— The degeneration of life is conditioned essentially by the extraordinary proneness to error of consciousness: it is held in check by instinct the least of all and therefore blunders the longest and the most thoroughly. To measure whether existence has value according to the pleasant or unpleasant feelings aroused in this consciousness: can one think of a madder extravagance of vanity? For it is only a means—and pleasant or unpleasant feelings are also only means! What is the objective measure of value? Solely the quantum of enhanced and organized power.⁶⁷

675 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

[The value of devaluing.— What I demand is]68 that one should take the doer back into the deed after having conceptually removed the doer and thus emptied the deed; that one should take doing something, the “aim,” the “intention,” the “purpose,” back into the deed after having artificially removed all this and thus emptied the deed. All “purposes,” “aims,” “meaning” are only modes of expression and metamorphoses of one will that is inherent in all events: the will to power. To have purposes, aims, intentions, willing in general, is the same thing as willing to be stronger, willing to grow—and, in addition, willing the means to this. The most universal and basic instinct in all doing and willing has for precisely this reason remained the least known and most hidden, because in praxi we always follow its commandments, because we are this commandment— All valuations are only consequences and narrow perspectives in the service of this one will: valuation itself is only this will to power. A critique of being from the point of view of any one of these values is something absurd and erroneous. Even supposing that a process of decline begins in this way, this process still stands in the service of this will. To appraise being itself! But this appraisal itself is still this being!—and if we say no, we still do what we are. One must comprehend the absurdity of this posture of judging existence, and then try to understand what is really involved in it. It is symptomatic. 676 (1883-1888) On the Origin of Our Evaluations We can analyze our body spatially, and then we gain precisely the same image of it as we have of the stellar system, and the distinction between the organic and inorganic is no longer noticeable. Formerly, one explained the motions of the stars as effects produced by entities conscious of a purpose. One no longer needs this explanation, and in regard to bodily motions and changes, too, one has long since abandoned the belief in an explanation by means of a consciousness that determines purposes. By far the greater number of motions have nothing whatever to do with consciousness; nor with sensation. Sensations and thoughts are something extremely insignificant and rare in relation to the countless number of events that occur every moment. On the other hand, we perceive that a purposiveness rules over the smallest events that is beyond our understanding: planning, selectivity, co-ordination, reparation, etc. In short, we discover an activity that would have to be ascribed to a far higher and more comprehensive intellect than we know of. We learn to think less highly of all that is conscious; we unlearn responsibility for ourselves, since we as conscious, purposive creatures, are only the smallest part of us. Of the numerous influences operating at every moment, e.g., air, electricity, we sense almost nothing; there could well be forces that, although we never sense them, continually influence us. Pleasure and pain are very rare and scarce appearances compared with the countless stimuli that a cell or organ exercises

upon another cell or organ. We are in the phase of modesty of consciousness. Ultimately, we understand the conscious ego itself only as a tool in the service of a higher, comprehensive intellect; and then we are able to ask whether all conscious willing, all conscious purposes, all evaluations are not perhaps only means through which something essentially different from what appears in consciousness is to be achieved. We think: it is a question of our pleasure and displeasure—but pleasure and displeasure could be means through which we have to achieve something that lies outside our consciousness.—It must be shown to what extent everything conscious remains on the surface; how an action and the image of an action differ, how little one knows of what precedes an action; how fantastic are our feelings of “freedom of will,” “cause and effect”; how thoughts and images are, like words, only signs of thoughts; the inexplicability of every action; the superficiality of all praise and blame; how essential fiction and conceits are in which we dwell consciously; how all our words refer to fictions (our affects, too), and how the bond between man and man depends on the transmission and elaboration of these fictions; while fundamentally the real bond (through procreation) goes its unknown way. Does this belief in common fictions really change men? Or is the entire realm of ideas and evaluations itself only an expression of unknown changes? Are there really will, purposes, thoughts, values? Is the whole of conscious life perhaps only a reflected image? And even when evaluation seems to determine the nature of a man, fundamentally something quite different is happening! In short: supposing that purposiveness in the work of nature could be explained without the assumption of an ego that posits purposes: could our positing of purposes, our willing, etc, not perhaps be also only a language of signs for something altogether different, namely something that does not will and is unconscious? Only the faintest reflection of that natural expediency in the organic but not different from it? Put briefly: perhaps the entire evolution of the spirit is a question of the body; it is the history of the development of a higher body that emerges into our sensibility. The organic is rising to yet higher levels. Our lust for knowledge of nature is a means through which the body desires to perfect itself. Or rather: hundreds of thousands of experiments are made to change the nourishment, the mode of living and of dwelling of the body; consciousness and evaluations in the body, all kinds of pleasure and displeasure, are signs of these changes and experiments. In the long run, it is not a question of man at all: he is to be overcome. 677 (1883-1888) To What Extent Interpretations of the World are Symptoms of a Ruling Drive The artistic view of the world. to sit down to contemplate life. But any analysis of the aesthetic outlook is lacking its reduction to cruelty, a feeling of security, playing the judge and standing outside, etc. One must examine the artist himself, and his psychology (critique of the drive to play as a release of force, a pleasure in change, in impressing one’s soul on something

foreign, the absolute egoism of the artist, etc.) What drives he sublimates. The scientific view of the world: critique of the psychological need for science. The desire to make comprehensible; the desire to make practical, useful, exploitable—to what extent anti-aesthetic. Only value, what can be counted and calculated. How an average type of man seeks to gain the upper hand in this way. Dreadful when history is appropriated in this way—the realm of the superior, of those who judge. What drives they sublime! The religious view of the world: critique of the religious man. He is not necessarily the moral man, but the man of powerful exaltations and deep depressions who interprets the former with gratitude or suspicion and does not derive them from himself (—not the latter either). Essentially the man who feels himself “unfree,” who sublimates his moods, his instincts of subjection. The moral view of the world: The feelings of a social order of rank are projected into the universe: irremovability, law, classification and co-ordination, because they are valued the highest, are also sought in the highest places—above the universe or behind the universe. What is common to all: the ruling drives want to be viewed also as the highest courts of value in general, indeed as creative and ruling powers. It is clear that these drives either oppose or subject each other (join together synthetically or alternate in dominating). Their profound antagonism is so great, however, that where they all seek satisfaction, a man of profound mediocrity must result. 678 (1883-1888) Whether the origin of our apparent “knowledge” is not to be sought solely in older evaluations which have become so much part of us that they belong to our basic constitution? So that what really happens is only that newer needs grapple with the results of the oldest needs? The world seen, felt, interpreted as thus and thus so that organic life may preserve itself in this perspective of interpretation. Man is not only a single individual but one particular line of the total living organic world. That he endures proves that a species of interpretation (even though accretions are still being added) has also endured, that the system of interpretation has not changed. “Adaptation.” Our “dissatisfaction,” our “ideal,” etc., is perhaps the consequence of this incorporated piece of interpretation, of our perspective point of view; perhaps organic life will in the end perish through it—even as the division of labor in organisms is accompanied by a withering and weakening of the parts, and finally leads to the death of the whole. The destruction of organic life, even in its highest form, must follow the same pattern as the destruction of the individual. 679 (1883-1888) Individuation, judged from the standpoint of the theory of descent, demonstrates a continual falling apart of one into two, and also the continual passing away of individuals who carry forward the evolution: by far the greater number die out every time (“the body”). The basic phenomenon: countless individuals sacrificed for the sake of a few, to make them possible.— One must not let oneself be deceived; it is just the same with peoples and races: they constitute the “body” for the production of isolated

valuable individuals, who carry on the great process. 680 (1883-1888) Against the theory that the isolated individual has in view the advantage of the species, of his posterity, at the cost of his own advantage: that is only an appearance. The tremendous importance the individual accords to the sexual instinct is not a result of its importance for the species, but arises because procreation is the real achievement of the individual and consequently his highest interest, his highest expression of power (not judged from the consciousness but from the center of the whole individuation). 681 (1883-1888) Basic errors of biologists hitherto: it is not a question of the species but of more powerful individuals. (The many are only a means). Life is not the adaptation of inner circumstances to outer ones, but will to power, which, working from within, incorporates and subdues more and more of that which is “outside.” These biologists carry forward moral evaluations (—the “higher value of altruism,” hostility against the lust to dominate, against war, against what is not useful, against orders of rank and class).

682 (Spring-Fall 1887)

In natural science, the moral depreciation of the ego goes hand in hand with an overestimation of the species. But the species is something just as illusory as the ego: one had made a false distinction. The ego is a hundred times more than merely a unit in the chain of members; it is this chain itself, entirely; and the species is a mere abstraction from the multiplicity of these chains and their partial similarity. That the individual is sacrificed to the species, as has so often been asserted, is certainly not a fact; rather only an example of false interpretation.

683 (March-June 1888)

Formula for the superstitious belief in “progress,” by a famous physiologist of the cerebral activities: “L’animal ne fait jamais de progrès comme espèce. L’homme seul fait de progrès comme espèce.”⁶⁸

684 (March-June 1888)

Anti-Darwin. The domestication of man: what definite value can it have? or has domestication in general any definite value?— There are grounds for denying the latter. The school of Darwin certainly makes a great effort to convince us of the reverse: it wants to show that the effect of domestication can become profound, even fundamental. In the meantime, we stick to our old opinion: up to now, domestication has produced only quite superficial effects—when it has not produced degeneration. And everything that eludes the hand and discipline of man returns almost at once to its natural state. The type remains constant: one cannot “*dénaturer la nature*.” One counts on the struggle for existence, the death of the weaker creatures and the survival of the most robust and gifted; consequently one imagines a continual growth in perfection. We have convinced ourselves, conversely, that in the struggle for existence chance serves the weak as well as the strong; that cunning often prevails over strength; that the fruitfulness of the species stands in a notable relation to its chances of destruction— One credits natural selection at the same time with the power of slow and endless metamorphosis; one wants to believe that every advantage is inherited and grows stronger and stronger with succeeding generations (whereas heredity is so capricious that—); one observes the fortunate adaptation of certain creatures to very special conditions of life, and one explains that these adaptations result from the influence of the milieu. But one nowhere finds any example of unconscious selection (absolutely not). The most disparate individuals unite with one another, the extremes are submerged in the mass. Everything competes to preserve its type; creatures with exterior markings to protect them from danger do not lose them when they encounter conditions in which they live without danger— When they live in places in which their dress ceases to hide them they do not by any means adapt to the new milieu. One has so exaggerated the selection of the most beautiful that it greatly exceeds the drive to beauty in our own race! In fact, the most beautiful mate with utterly disinherited creatures, and the biggest with the smallest. We almost always see males and females take advantage of any chance encounter, exhibiting no selectivity whatsoever.— Modification through food and climate—but in reality a matter of complete indifference. There are no transitional forms.— Different species derived from one Experience says that one type becomes master again.⁶⁹ One asserts the increasing evolution of creatures. All grounds are lacking. Every type has its limits; beyond these there is no evolution. Up to this point, absolute regularity. Primitive creatures are said to be the ancestors of those now existing. But a look at the fauna and flora of the Tertiary merely permits us to think of an as yet unexplored country that harbors types that do not exist elsewhere, while those existing elsewhere are missing.⁷⁰ * My general view.— First proposition: man as a species is not progressing.

Higher types are indeed attained, but they do not last. The level of the species is not raised. Second proposition: man as a species does not represent any progress compared with any other animal. The whole animal and vegetable kingdom does not evolve from the lower to the higher—but all at the same time, in utter disorder, over and against each other. The richest and most complex forms—for the expression “higher type” means no more than this—perish more easily: only the lowest preserve an apparent indestructibility. The former are achieved only rarely and maintain their superiority with difficulty; the latter are favored by a compromising fruitfulness. Among men, too, the higher types, the lucky strokes of evolution, perish most easily as fortunes change. They are exposed to every kind of decadence: they are extreme, and that almost means decadents. The brief spell of beauty, of genius, of Caesar, is *sui generis*: such things are not inherited. The type is hereditary; a type is nothing extreme, no “lucky stroke”—This is not due to any special fatality or malevolence of nature, but simply to the concept “higher type”: the higher type represents an incomparably greater complexity—a greater sum of co-ordinated elements: so its disintegration is also incomparably more likely. The “genius” is the sublimest machine there is—consequently the most fragile. Third proposition: the domestication (the “culture”) of man does not go deep—Where it does go deep it at once becomes degeneration (type: the Christian). The “savage” (or, in moral terms, the evil man) is a return to nature—and in a certain sense his recovery, his cure from “culture”—

685 (March-June 1888)

Anti-Darwin.— What surprises me most when I survey the broad destinies of man is that I always see before me the opposite of that which Darwin and his school see or want to see today: selection in favor of the stronger, better-constituted, and the progress of the species. Precisely the opposite is palpable: the elimination of the lucky strokes, the uselessness of the more highly developed types, the inevitable dominion of the average, even the sub-average types. If we are not shown why man should be an exception among creatures, I incline to the prejudice that the school of Darwin has been deluded everywhere. That will to power in which I recognize the ultimate ground and character of all change provides us with the reason why selection is not in favor of the exceptions and lucky strokes: the strongest and most fortunate are weak when opposed by organized herd instincts, by the timidity of the weak, by the vast majority. My general view of the world of values shows that it is not the lucky strokes, the select types, that have the upper hand in the supreme values that are today placed over mankind; rather it is the decadent types—perhaps there is nothing in the world more interesting than this unwelcome spectacle— Strange though it may sound, one always has to defend the strong against the weak; the fortunate against the unfortunate; the healthy against those degenerating and afflicted with hereditary taints. If one translates reality into a morality, this morality is: the mediocre are worth more than the exceptions; the decadent forms more than the mediocre; the will to nothingness has the upper hand over the will to life—and the overall aim is, in Christian, Buddhist, Schopenhauerian terms: “better not to be than to be.” I rebel against the translation of reality into a morality: therefore I abhor Christianity with a deadly hatred, because it created sublime words and gestures to throw over a horrible reality the cloak of justice, virtue, and divinity—I see all philosophers, I see science kneeling before a reality that is the reverse of the struggle for existence as taught by Darwin’s school—that is to say, I see on top and surviving everywhere those who compromise life and the value of life.— The error of the school of Darwin becomes a problem to me: how can one be so blind as to see so badly at this point? That species represent any progress is the most unreasonable assertion in the world: so far they represent one level. That the higher organisms have evolved from the lower has not been demonstrated in a single case. I see how the lower preponderate through their numbers, their shrewdness, their cunning—I do not see how an accidental variation gives an advantage, at least not for so long a period; why an accidental change should grow so strong would be something else needing explanation. I find the “cruelty of nature,” of which so much is said, in another place: she is cruel towards her children of fortune, she spares and protects and loves les humbles, just as—72 In summa: growth in the power of a

species is perhaps guaranteed less by a preponderance of its children of fortune, of strong members, than by a preponderance of average and lower types— The latter possess great fruitfulness and duration; with the former comes an increase in danger, rapid wastage, speedy reduction in numbers. 686 (1884) Man hitherto—as it were, an embryo of the man of the future;—all the form-giving forces directed toward the latter are present in the former; and because they are tremendous, the more a present-day individual determines the future, the more he will suffer. This is the profoundest conception of suffering: the form-giving forces are in painful collision.— The isolation of the individual ought not to deceive us: something flows on underneath individuals. That the individual feels himself isolated is itself the most powerful goad in the process towards the most distant goals: his search for his happiness is the means that holds together and moderates the form-giving forces, so they do not destroy themselves.

687 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Superabundant force in spirituality, setting itself new goals; by no means merely commanding and leading on behalf of the lower world or the preservation of the organism, the “individual.” We are more than the individuals: we are the whole chain as well, with the tasks of all the futures of that chain.

688 (March-June 1888)

Unitary conception of psychology— We are accustomed to consider the development of an immense abundance of forms compatible with an origin in unity. [My theory would be:—]73 that the will to power is the primitive form of affect, that all other affects are only developments of it; that it is notably enlightening to posit power in place of individual “happiness” (after which every living thing is supposed to be striving): “there is a striving for power, for an increase of power”;—pleasure is only a symptom of the feeling of power attained, a consciousness of a difference (—there is no striving for pleasure: but pleasure supervenes when that which is being striven for is attained: pleasure is an accompaniment, pleasure is not the motive—); that all driving force is will to power, that there is no other physical, dynamic or psychic force except this. In our science, where the concept of cause and effect is reduced to the relationship of equivalence, with the object of proving that the same quantum of force is present on both sides, the driving force is lacking: we observe only results, and we consider them equivalent in content and force— It is simply a matter of experience that change never ceases: we have not the slightest inherent reason for assuming that one change must follow upon another. On the contrary: a condition once achieved would seem to be obliged to preserve itself if there were not in it a capacity for desiring not to preserve itself— Spinoza’s law of “self-preservation” ought really to put a stop to change: but this law is false, the opposite is true. It can be shown most clearly that every living thing does everything it can not to preserve itself but to become more—

689 (March-June 1888)

Critique of the concept: cause.⁷⁵— From a psychological point of view the concept “cause” is our feeling of power resulting from the so-called act of will—our concept “effect” the superstition that this feeling of power is the motive power itself— A condition that accompanies an event and is itself an effect of the event is projected as the “sufficient reason” for the event;— the relation of tensions in our feeling of power (pleasure as the feeling of power), of a resistance overcome—are they illusions?— If we translate the concept “cause” back to the only sphere known to us, from which we have derived it, we cannot imagine any change that does not involve a will to power. We do not know how to explain a change except as the encroachment of one power upon another power.

Mechanics shows us only the results, and then only in images (motion is a figure of speech). Gravity itself has no mechanistic cause, since it itself is the ground of mechanistic results. The will to accumulate force is special to the phenomena of life, to nourishment, procreation, inheritance—to society, state, custom, authority. Should we not be permitted to assume this will as a motive cause in chemistry, too?—and in the cosmic order? Not merely conservation of energy, but maximal economy in use, so the only reality is the will to grow stronger of every center of force—not self-preservation, but the will to appropriate, dominate, increase, grow stronger. The possibility of science should be proved by a principle of causality?⁷⁶ “From like causes like effects”— “A permanent law governing things”—“An invariable order”?— Because something is calculable, does that mean it is necessary? If something happens thus and not otherwise, that does not imply a “principle,” “law,” “order,” [but the operation of]⁷⁷ quanta of force the essence of which consists in exercising power against other quanta of force. Can we assume a striving for power divorced from a sensation of pleasure and displeasure, i.e., divorced from the feeling of enhanced or diminished power? Is mechanism only a sign language for the internal factual world of struggling and conquering quanta of will? All the presuppositions of mechanistic theory—matter, atom, gravity, pressure and stress—are not “facts-in-themselves” but interpretations with the aid of psychical fictions. Life, as the form of being most familiar to us, is specifically a will to the accumulation of force; all the processes of life depend on this: nothing wants to preserve itself, everything is to be added and accumulated. Life as a special case (hypothesis based upon it applied to the total character of being—) strives after a maximal feeling of power; essentially a striving for more power; striving is nothing other than striving for power; the basic and innermost thing is still this will. (Mechanics is merely the semeiotics of the results.)

690 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

One cannot discover the cause of there being any evolution at all by studying evolution; one should not wish to think of it as “becoming,” even less as having become— The “will to power” cannot have become. 691 (1885-1886) What has been the relation of the total organic process to the rest of nature?— That is where its fundamental will stands revealed.

692 (March-June 1888)

Is “will to power” a kind of “will” or identical with the concept “will”? Is it the same thing as desiring? or commanding? Is it that “will” of which Schopenhauer said it was the “in-itself of things”? My proposition is: that the will of psychology hitherto is an unjustified generalization, that this will does not exist at all, that instead of grasping the idea of the development of one definite will into many forms, one has eliminated the character of the will by subtracting from it its content, its “whither?”—this is in the highest degree the case with Schopenhauer: what he calls “will” is a mere empty word. It is even less a question of a “will to live”; for life is merely a special case of the will to power;—it is quite arbitrary to assert that everything strives to enter into this form of the will to power.

693 (March-June 1888)

If the innermost essence of being is will to power, if pleasure is every increase of power, displeasure every feeling of not being able to resist or dominate; may we not then posit pleasure and displeasure as cardinal facts? Is will possible without these two oscillations of Yes and No?— But who feels pleasure?— But who wants power?— Absurd question, if the essence itself is power-will and consequently feelings of pleasure and displeasure! Nonetheless: opposites, obstacles are needed; therefore, relatively, encroaching units—

694 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The measure of failure and fatality must grow with the resistance a force seeks to master; and as a force can expend itself only on what resists it, there is necessarily an ingredient of displeasure in every action. But this displeasure acts as a lure of life and strengthens the will to power!

695 (March-June 1888)

If pleasure and displeasure relate to the feeling of power, then life must represent a growth in power, so that the difference caused by this growth must enter consciousness— If one level of power were maintained, pleasure would have only lowerings of this level by which to set its standards, only states of displeasure—not states of pleasure— The will to grow is of the essence of pleasure: that power increases, that the difference enters consciousness. From a certain point onwards, in decadence, the opposite difference enters consciousness, the decrease: the memory of former moments of strength depresses present feelings of pleasure—comparison now weakens pleasure.

696 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

It is not the satisfaction of the will that causes pleasure (I want to fight this superficial theory—the absurd psychological counterfeiting of the nearest things —), but rather the will's forward thrust and again and again becoming master over that which stands in its way. The feeling of pleasure lies precisely in the dissatisfaction of the will, in the fact that the will is never satisfied unless it has opponents and resistance.— “The happy man”: a herd ideal.

697 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The normal dissatisfaction of our drives, e g., hunger, the sexual drive, the drive to motion, contains in it absolutely nothing depressing; it works rather as an agitation of the feeling of life, as every rhythm of small, painful stimuli strengthens it, (whatever pessimists may say). This dissatisfaction, instead of making one disgusted with life, is the great stimulus to life. (One could perhaps describe pleasure in general as a rhythm of little unpleasurable stimuli.)

698 (Summer-Fall 1883)

Kant said: “I subscribe entirely to these sentences of Count Verri (Sull’ indole del piacere e del dolore; 1781): Il solo principio motore dell’ uomo è il dolore. Il dolore precede ogni piacere. Il piacere non è un essere positivo.”⁷⁸

699 (March-June 1888)

Pain is something different from pleasure—I mean it is not its opposite. If the essence of “pleasure” has been correctly described as a feeling of more power (hence as a feeling of difference, presupposing a comparison), this does not yet furnish a definition of the essence of “displeasure.” The false opposites in which the people, and consequently language, believes, have always been dangerous hindrances to the advance of truth. There are even cases in which a kind of pleasure is conditioned by a certain rhythmic sequence of little unpleasurable stimuli: in this way a very rapid increase of the feeling of power, the feeling of pleasure, is achieved. This is the case, e.g., in tickling, also the sexual tickling in the act of coitus: here we see displeasure at work as an ingredient of pleasure. It seems, a little hindrance that is overcome and immediately followed by another little hindrance that is again overcome—this game of resistance and victory arouses most strongly that general feeling of superabundant, excessive power that constitutes the essence of pleasure. The opposite, an increase in the sensation of pain through the introduction of little pleasurable stimuli, is lacking; for pleasure and pain are not opposites. Pain is an intellectual occurrence in which a definite judgment is expressed—the judgment “harmful” in which a long experience is summarized. There is no pain as such. It is not being wounded that hurts; but the experience of the bad consequences being wounded can have for the whole organism expresses itself in that profound shock that is called displeasure; (in the case of harmful influences with which former men were unacquainted, e.g., those of new combinations of poisonous chemicals, pain bears no witness—and we are lost). The really specific thing in pain is always the protracted shock, the lingering vibrations of a terrifying choc in the cerebral center of the nervous system:— one does not really suffer from the cause of pain (any sort of injury, for example), but from the protracted disturbance of equilibrium that occurs as a result of the choc. Pain is a sickness of the cerebral nerve centers—pleasure is certainly not a sickness. That pain is the cause of reflex actions has appearance and even the prejudice of philosophers in its favor; but, if one observes it closely, in cases of sudden pain the reflex comes noticeably earlier than the sensation of pain. It would go ill with me if, when I stumbled, I had to wait for the fact to ring the bell of consciousness and for instructions how to act to be telegraphed back. What I notice with the greatest possible clarity is rather that the reflex of my foot follows first to prevent my falling, and then, at a measurable distance in time, the sudden sensation of a kind of painful wave in the front part of my head. Thus one does not react to the pain. Pain is subsequently projected to the wounded place—but the nature of this local pain is nonetheless not an expression of the kind of the local injury; it is a mere place-sign corresponding to the force and pitch of the injury the nerve centers

have received. That as a result of this choc the muscular strength of the organism is measurably lowered does not warrant our seeking the essence of pain in a diminution of the feeling of power. To repeat it again, one does not react to pain; displeasure is not a “cause” of action. Pain itself is a reaction, the reflex is another and earlier reaction—both originate in different places— 700
(1883-1888) Intellectual nature of pain: it does not indicate what has been damaged at the moment, but the value of the damage in relation to the individual as a whole. Whether there are pains from which “the species” and not the individual suffers—?

701 (Nov. 1887-March 1883)

“The sum of displeasure outweighs the sum of pleasure; consequently it would be better if the world did not exist”— “The world is something that rationally should not exist because it causes the feeling subject more displeasure than pleasure”—chatter of this sort calls itself pessimism today! Pleasure and displeasure are accidentals, not causes; they are value judgments of the second rank, derived from a ruling value— “useful,” “harmful,” speaking in the form of feelings, and consequently absolutely sketchy and dependent. For with every “useful,” “harmful,” one still has to ask in a hundred different ways: “for what?” I despise this pessimism of sensibility: it is itself a sign of deeply impoverished life.⁷⁹

702 (March-June 1888)

Man does not seek pleasure and does not avoid displeasure: one will realize which famous prejudice I am contradicting. Pleasure and displeasure are mere consequences, mere epiphenomena—what man wants, what every smallest part of a living organism wants, is an increase of power. Pleasure or displeasure follow from the striving after that; driven by that will it seeks resistance, it needs something that opposes it— Displeasure, as an obstacle to its will to power, is therefore a normal fact, the normal ingredient of every organic event; man does not avoid it, he is rather in continual need of it; every victory, every feeling of pleasure, every event, presupposes a resistance overcome. Let us take the simplest case, that of primitive nourishment: the protoplasm extends its pseudopodia in search of something that resists it—not from hunger but from will to power.⁸⁰ Thereupon it attempts to overcome, appropriate, assimilate what it encounters: what one calls “nourishment” is merely a derivative phenomenon, an application of the original will to become stronger. Displeasure thus does not merely not have to result in a diminution of our feeling of power, but in the average case it actually stimulates this feeling of power—the obstacle is the stimulus of this will to power.

703 (March-June 1888)

One has confused displeasure with one kind of displeasure, with exhaustion; the latter does indeed represent a profound diminution and reduction of the will to power, a measurable loss of force. That is to say: there exists (a) displeasure as a means of stimulating the increase of power, and (b) displeasure following an overexpenditure of power; in the first case a stimulus, in the second the result of an excessive stimulation— Inability to resist is characteristic of the latter kind of displeasure: a challenge to that which resists belongs to the former— The only pleasure still felt in the condition of exhaustion is falling asleep; victory is the pleasure in the other case— The great confusion on the part of psychologists consisted in not distinguishing between these two kinds of pleasure—that of falling asleep and that of victory. The exhausted want rest, relaxation, peace, calm—the happiness of the nihilistic religions and philosophies; the rich and living want victory, opponents overcome, the overflow of the feeling of power across wider domains than hitherto All healthy functions of the organism have this need—and the whole organism is such a complex of systems struggling for an increase of the feeling of power——

704 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

How does it happen that the basic articles of faith in psychology are one and all the most arrant misrepresentations and counterfeits? “Man strives after happiness,” e.g.—how much of that is true? In order to understand what “life” is, what kind of striving and tension life is, the formula must apply as well to trees and plants as to animals. “What does a plant strive after?”—but here we have already invented a false unity which does not exist: the fact of a millionfold growth with individual and semi-individual initiatives is concealed and denied if we begin by positing a crude unity “plant.” That the very smallest “individuals” cannot be understood in the sense of a “metaphysical individuality” and atom, that their sphere of power is continually changing—that is the first thing that becomes obvious; but does each of them strive after happiness when it changes in this way?— But all expansion, incorporation, growth means striving against something that resists; motion is essentially tied up with states of displeasure; that which is here the driving force must in any event desire something else if it desires displeasure in this way and continually looks for it.— For what do the trees in a jungle fight each other? For “happiness”?— For power!— Man, become master over the forces of nature, master over his own savagery and licentiousness (the desires have learned to obey and be useful)—man, in comparison with a pre-man—represents a tremendous quantum of power—not an increase in “happiness”! How can one claim that he has striven for happiness? — 705 (1883-1888)⁸² As I say this I see above me, glittering under the stars, the tremendous rat’s tail of errors that has hitherto counted as the highest inspiration of humanity: “All happiness is a consequence of virtue, all virtue is a consequence of free will!” Let us reverse the values: all fitness the result of fortunate organization, all freedom the result of fitness (—freedom here understood as facility in self-direction. Every artist will understand me).

706 (Spring-Fall 1887)

“The value of life.”— Life is a unique case; one must justify all existence and not only life—the justifying principle is one that explains life, too. Life is only a means to something; it is the expression of forms of the growth of power.

707 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

The “conscious world” cannot serve as a starting point for values: need for an “objective” positing of values. In relation to the vastness and multiplicity of collaboration and mutual opposition encountered in the life of every organism, the conscious world of feelings, intentions, and valuations is a small section. We have no right whatever to posit this piece of consciousness as the aim and wherefore of this total phenomenon of life: becoming conscious is obviously only one more means toward the unfolding and extension of the power of life. Therefore it is a piece of naiveté to posit pleasure or spirituality or morality or any other particular of the sphere of consciousness as the highest value—and perhaps even to justify “the world” by means of this. This is my basic objection to all philosophic-moralistic cosmo- and theodicies, to all wherefores and highest values in philosophy and theology hitherto. One kind of means has been misunderstood as an end; conversely, life and the enhancement of its power has been debased to a means. If we wished to postulate a goal adequate to life, it could not coincide with any category of conscious life; it would rather have to explain all of them as a means to itself— The “denial of life” as an aim of life, an aim of evolution! Existence as a great stupidity! Such a lunatic interpretation is only the product of measuring life by aspects of consciousness (pleasure and displeasure, good and evil). Here the means are made to stand against the end—the “unholy,” absurd, above all unpleasant means—: how can an end that employs such means be worth anything! But the mistake is that, instead of looking for a purpose that explains the necessity of such means, we presuppose in advance a goal that actually excludes such means; ie., we take a desideratum in respect of certain means (namely pleasant, rational, and virtuous ones) as a norm, on the basis of which we posit what general purpose would be desirable— The fundamental mistake is simply that, instead of understanding consciousness as a tool and particular aspect of the total life, we posit it as the standard and the condition of life that is of supreme value: it is the erroneous perspective of a *parte ad totum*—which is why all philosophers are instinctively trying to imagine a total consciousness, a consciousness involved in all life and will, in all that occurs, a “spirit,” “God.” But one has to tell them that precisely this turns life into a monstrosity; that a “God” and total sensorium would altogether be something on account of which life would have to be condemned— Precisely that we have eliminated the total consciousness that posited ends and means, is our great relief—with that we are no longer compelled to be pessimists— Our greatest reproach against existence was the existence of God—

708 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

[On the value of “becoming.”—]85 If the motion of the world aimed at a final state, that state would have been reached. The sole fundamental fact, however, is that it does not aim at a final state; and every philosophy and scientific hypothesis (e.g., mechanistic theory) which necessitates such a final state is refuted by this fundamental fact. I seek a conception of the world that takes this fact into account. Becoming must be explained without recourse to final intentions; becoming must appear justified at every moment (or incapable of being evaluated; which amounts to the same thing); the present must absolutely not be justified by reference to a future, nor the past by reference to the present. “Necessity” not in the shape of an overreaching, dominating total force, or that of a prime mover; even less as a necessary condition for something valuable. To this end it is necessary to deny a total consciousness of becoming, a “God,” to avoid bringing all events under the aegis of a being who feels and knows but does not will: “God” is useless if he does not want anything, and moreover this means positing a summation of displeasure and unlogic which would debase the total value of “becoming.” Fortunately such a summarizing power is missing (—a suffering and all-seeing God, a “total sensorium” and “cosmic spirit”⁸⁶ would be the greatest objection to being). More strictly: one must admit nothing that has being— because then becoming would lose its value and actually appear meaningless and superfluous. Consequently one must ask how the illusion of being could have arisen (was bound to arise); likewise: how all value judgments that rest on the hypothesis that there are beings are disvalued. But here one realizes that this hypothesis of beings is the source of all world-defamation (—the “better world,” the “true world,” the “world beyond,” the “thing-in-itself.”) Becoming does not aim at a final state, does not flow into “being.” Becoming is not a merely apparent state; perhaps the world of beings is mere appearance. Becoming is of equivalent value every moment; the sum of its values always remains the same; in other words, it has no value at all, for anything against which to measure it, and in relation to which the word “value” would have meaning, is lacking. The total value of the world cannot be evaluated; consequently philosophical pessimism belongs among comical things.

709 (Spring-Fall 1887)

That we do not make our “desiderata” judges of being! That we do not also set up terminal forms of evolution (e g., spirit) as another “in-itself” behind evolution!

710 (March-June 1888)

Our knowledge has become scientific to the extent that it is able to employ number and measure. The attempt should be made to see whether a scientific order of values could be constructed simply on a numerical and mensural scale of force— All other “values” are prejudices, naiveties, misunderstandings.— They are everywhere reducible to this numerical and mensural scale of force. The ascent on this scale represents every rise in value; the descent on this scale represents diminution in value. Here one has appearance and prejudice against one. (For moral values are only apparent values compared with physiological values.)

711 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Where the point of view of “value” is inadmissible:— That in the “process of the totality” the labor of man is of no account, because a total process (considered as a system—) does not exist at all; that there is no “totality”; that no evaluation of human existence, of human aims, can be made in regard to something that does not exist; that “necessity,” “causality,” “purposiveness,” are useful unrealities;⁸⁷ that not “increase in consciousness” is the aim, but enhancement of power—and in this enhancement the utility of consciousness is included; the same applies to pleasure and displeasure; that one does not take the means as the supreme measure of value (therefore not states of consciousness, such as pleasure and pain, if becoming conscious itself is only a means—); that the world is not an organism at all, but chaos; that the evolution of “spirituality” is only a means towards the relative duration of the organization; that all “desirability” has no meaning in relation to the total character of being.

712 (Spring-Fall 1887)

“God” as the moment of culmination: existence an eternal deifying and undeifying. But in that not a high point of value, but a high point of power. Absolute exclusion of mechanism and matter: both are only expressions of lower stages, the most despiritualized form of affect (of “will to power”).⁸⁸ Retreat from the high-point in becoming (the highest spiritualization of power on the most slavish ground) to be represented as a consequence of this highest force, which, turning against itself when it no longer has anything left to organize, expends its force on disorganization— a. The ever-increasing conquest of societies and subjection of them by a smaller but more powerful number; b. the ever-increasing conquest of the privileged and stronger and the consequent rise of democracy, and ultimately anarchy of the elements.

713 (March-June 1888)

Value is the highest quantum of power that a man is able to incorporate—a man: not mankind! Mankind is even a means sooner than an end. It is a question of the type: mankind is merely the experimental material, the tremendous surplus of failures: a field of ruins.⁸⁹

714 (Manuscript source uncertain)

Value words are banners raised where a new bliss has been found—a new feeling.

715 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The standpoint of “value” is the standpoint of conditions of preservation and enhancement for complex forms of relative life-duration within the flux of becoming. There are no durable ultimate units, no atoms, no monads: here, too, “beings” are only introduced by us (from perspective grounds of practicality and utility). “Forms of domination”; the sphere of that which is dominated continually growing or periodically increasing and decreasing according to the favorability or unfavorability of circumstances (nourishment—). “Value” is essentially the standpoint for the increase or decrease of these dominating centers (“multiplicities” in any case; but “units” are nowhere present in the nature of becoming).⁹⁰ Linguistic means of expression are useless for expressing “becoming”; it accords with our inevitable need to preserve ourselves to posit a crude world of stability, of “things,” etc. We may venture to speak of atoms and monads in a relative sense; and it is certain that the smallest world is the most durable— There is no will: there are treaty drafts of will that are constantly increasing or losing their power. 55 “Whistling out of the final hole” is a German expression for extreme emergencies. Cf. my note 54 above. 68 “Animals never progress as a species. Only man progresses as a species.” 72 “Just as” is omitted in all editions. These ideas, as well as many of those developed in the following sections, down through 715, are discussed in Chapter 9, “Power versus Pleasure,” of my Nietzsche 75 I have restored the title found in the MS In the printed texts a title devised by Peter Gast has been substituted: “Will to power and causalism.” 83 “The last three lines are crossed out in the MS”: 1911, p. 510. Unless “three” is a misprint (for two), the deletion would begin at the point indicated. 86 “Allgeist.” 87 Nützliche “Scheinbarkeiten” “The world made stupid, as an aim, as a consequence of the will to power which makes the elements as independent of each other as possible. Beauty as a sign of the habituation and pampering [Gewöhnung und Verwöhnung] of the victorious; what is ugly as the expression of many defeats (within the organism). No heredity! The chain as a whole changing—” On the margin of the same page: “ ‘Beautiful’ has a delightful effect on the feeling of pleasure; one need only think of the transfiguring power of ‘love.’ Might not the transfigured and perfect, conversely, mildly excite sensuality, so life has the effect of a pleasant feeling? —” III. THE WILL TO POWER AS SOCIETY AND INDIVIDUAL

716 (March-June 1888)

Basic principle: only individuals feel themselves responsible. Multiplicities are invented in order to do things for which the individual lacks the courage. It is for just this reason that all communalities and societies are a hundred times more upright and instructive about the nature of man than is the individual, who is too weak to have the courage for his own desires— The whole of “altruism” reveals itself as the prudence of the private man: societies are not “altruistic” towards one another— The commandment to love one’s neighbor has never yet been extended to include one’s actual neighbor. That relationship is still governed by the words of Manu: “We must consider all countries that have common borders with us, and their allies, too, as our enemies. For the same reason, we must count all their neighbors as being well-disposed toward us.” The study of society is so invaluable because man as society is much more naive than man as a “unit.” “ ‘Society’ has never regarded virtue as anything but a means to strength, power, and order. How simple and dignified is Manu when he says: “Virtue could scarcely endure by its own strength. Fundamentally it is only the fear of punishment that keeps men within bounds and leaves everyone in peaceful possession of his own.”⁹²

717 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The state organized immorality—internally: as police, penal law, classes, commerce, family; externally: as will to power, to war, to conquest, to revenge. How does it happen that the state will do a host of things that the individual would never countenance?— Through division of responsibility, of command, and of execution. Through the interposition of the virtues of obedience, duty, patriotism, and loyalty. Through upholding pride, severity, strength, hatred, revenge—in short, all typical characteristics that contradict the herd type.

718 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

None of you has the courage to kill a man, or even to whip him, or even to—but the tremendous machine of the state overpowers the individual, so he repudiates responsibility for what he does (obedience, oath, etc.) —Everything a man does in the service of the state is contrary to his nature. —in the same way, everything he learns with a view to future state service is contrary to his nature. This is achieved through division of labor (so that no one any longer possesses the full responsibility) : the lawgiver—and he who enacts the law; the teacher of discipline—and those who have grown hard and severe under discipline.

719 (Spring-Fall 1887)

A division of labor among the affects within society: so individuals and classes produce an incomplete, but for that reason more useful kind of soul. To what extent certain affects have remained almost rudimentary in every type within society (with a view to developing another affect more strongly). Justification of morality: economic (the intention to exploit individual strength to the greatest possible extent to prevent the squandering of everything exceptional); aesthetic (the formation of firm types, together with pleasure in one's own type); political (the art of enduring the tremendous tension between differing degrees of power); physiological (as a pretended high evaluation in favor of the underprivileged or mediocre—for the preservation of the weak). 720 (1886-1887) The most fearful and fundamental desire in man, his drive for power—this drive is called “freedom”— must be held in check the longest. This is why ethics, with its unconscious instinct for education and breeding, has hitherto aimed at holding the desire for power in check: it disparages the tyrannical individual and with its glorification of social welfare and patriotism emphasizes the power-instinct of the herd

721 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Inability to acquire power: its hypocrisy and shrewdness: as obedience (subordination, pride in duty, morality—); as submission, devotion, love (idealization, deification of him who commands as compensation and indirect self-transfiguration); as fatalism, resignation; as “objectivity”; as self-tyranny (Stoicism, asceticism, “emancipation from the self,” “sanctification”); as criticism, pessimism, indignation, torment; as “beautiful soul,” “virtue,” “self-deification,” “detachment,” “unspotted by the world,” etc. (—the insight into an inability to acquire power disguised as *dédain*). In all this there is expressed the need to exercise some sort of power nonetheless, or to create for oneself the temporary appearance of power—as intoxication. Men who want power for the sake of the happiness power provides: political parties Other men who want power even accompanied by obvious disadvantages and sacrifices in happiness and well-being: the ambitious. Other men who want power merely because it would otherwise fall into other hands upon which they do not want to be dependent. 722 (1886-1887) Critique of “justice” and “equality before the law”: what is really supposed to be abolished through this? Tension, enmity, hatred.— But it is an error to suppose that “happiness” will be increased in this way: Corsicans, e g, enjoy more happiness than Continentals.

723 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Reciprocity, the hidden intention to claim reward: one of the most insidious forms of the diminution of the value of man. It brings with it that “equality” which depreciates the distancing gulf as immoral—

724 (Spring-Fall 1887)

What “useful” means is entirely dependent upon the intention, the wherefore? The intention, the “goal,” is again entirely dependent on the degree of power. Therefore utilitarianism is not a foundation but only a theory of consequences, and absolutely cannot be made obligatory for everyone.

725 (Summer-Fall 1883)

Formerly one had the theory of the state as a calculating utility: now one has the practice as well!— The age of kings is past because the peoples are no longer worthy of them: they do not want to see the symbol of their ideal in kings, but a means for their profit.— That is the whole truth!

726 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Attempt on my part to grasp the absolute rationality of social judgment and evaluation (naturally without the desire to deduce moral conclusions). the degree of psychological falsity and opacity needed to sanctify the affects essential for preservation and enhancement of power (in order to create a good conscience for them). the degree of stupidity needed to maintain the possibility of common rules and valuations (in addition education, supervision of the elements of culture, training). the degree of inquisition, mistrust, and intolerance needed to deal with the exceptions as criminals and to suppress them—to give them a bad conscience, so they suffer their exceptionalness as a disease.

727 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Morality essentially a shield, a means of defense; to this extent a sign of the immature (armored, stoical). The mature man has, above all, weapons: he attacks. Instruments of war transformed into instruments of peace (from scales and armor, feathers and hair).

728 (March-June 1888)

It is part of the concept of the living that it must grow—that it must extend its power and consequently incorporate alien forces. Intoxicated by moral narcotics, one speaks of the right of the individual to defend himself; in the same sense one might also speak of his right to attack: for both—and the second even more than the first—are necessities for every living thing:— aggressive and defensive egoism are not matters of choice, to say nothing of “free will,” but the fatality of life itself. In this case it is all the same whether one has in view an individual or a living body, an aspiring “society.” The right to punish (or the self-defense of society) is at bottom called a “right” owing to a misuse of the word. A right is acquired through treaties—but self-protection and self-defense do not rest on the basis of a treaty. At least a people might just as well designate as a right its need to conquer, its lust for power, whether by means of arms or by trade, commerce and colonization—the right to growth, perhaps. A society that definitely and instinctively gives up war and conquest is in decline: it is ripe for democracy and the rule of shopkeepers— In most cases, to be sure, assurances of peace are merely narcotics.

729 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The maintenance of the military state is the last means of all of acquiring or maintaining the great tradition with regard to the supreme type of man, the strong type. And all concepts that perpetuate enmity and difference in rank between states (e.g., nationalism, protective tariffs) may appear sanctioned in this light. 730 (1885-1886) That something longer-lasting than an individual should endure, that a work should endure which has perhaps been created by an individual: to that end, every possible kind of limitation, one-sidedness, etc., must be imposed upon the individual. By what means? Love, reverence, gratitude toward the person who created the work helps; or that our forefathers fought for it; or that my descendants will be guaranteed only if I guarantee this work (e.g., the polis). Morality is essentially the means of ensuring the duration of something beyond individuals, or rather through an enslavement of the individual. It is obvious that the perspective from below will produce quite different expressions from that from above. A complex of power: how is it maintained? By the fact that many generations sacrifice themselves for it; i.e.,—93

731 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The continuum: “marriage, property, language, tradition, tribe, family, people, state” are continuums of lower and higher orders. Their economy resides in the preponderance of the advantages of uninterrupted work and of multiplicity over the disadvantages: the higher cost of exchange between parts or of making them last. (Multiplication of the effective parts, which, however, often remain unemployed; thus a higher cost of acquisition and a not inconsiderable cost in maintenance.) The advantage resides in the fact that interruptions are avoided and losses that would arise from them are saved. Nothing is more costly than a beginning. “The greater the advantages for existence, the greater the cost of maintenance and production (food and propagation); the greater, too, the danger and probability of perishing before the high point is reached.”

732 (Summer-Fall 1888)

Marriage in the bourgeois sense of the word—I mean, in the most respectable sense of the word “marriage”—is not a matter of love, any more than it is a question of money; no institution can be founded on love. It is a question of society’s granting permission to two people to gratify their sexual desires with one another, under certain conditions, to be sure, but conditions that keep the interests of society in view. It is obvious that a certain attraction between the parties and very much good will—will to patience, compatibility, care for one another—will be among the presuppositions of such a contract; but one should not misuse the word love to describe this! For two lovers in the complete and strong sense of the word sexual gratification is not essential and is really no more than a symbol: for one party, as already said, a symbol of unconditional submission, for the other a symbol of assent to this, a sign of taking possession. In marriage in the aristocratic, old aristocratic sense of the word it was a question of the breeding of a race (is there still an aristocracy today? *Quaeritur*)—thus of the maintenance of a fixed, definite type of ruling man: man and woman were sacrificed to this point of view. It is obvious that love was not the first consideration here; on the contrary! and not even that measure of mutual good will that is a condition of the good bourgeois marriage. What was decisive was the interest of a family, and beyond that—the class. We would shiver a little at the coldness, severity, and calculating clarity of such a noble concept of marriage as has ruled in every healthy aristocracy, in ancient Athens as in the eighteenth century, we warm-blooded animals with sensitive hearts, we “moderns”! Precisely this is why love as a passion—in the great meaning of the word—was invented for the aristocratic world and in it, where constraint and privation were greatest— 733 (1888) On the future of marriage:—an additional tax (on inheritance), also additional war service for bachelors from a certain age onwards and increasing (within the community); advantages of all kinds for fathers who bring many boys into the world: possibly a plural vote; a medical certificate preceding every marriage and endorsed by the communal authorities, several definite questions must be answered by the couple and by doctors (“family history”); as an antidote to prostitution (or as its ennoblement): marriages for a period, legalized (for years, for months), with guarantees for the children; every marriage warranted and sanctioned by a certain number of trusted men of the community, as a matter of concern to the community.⁹⁶

734 (Summer-Fall 1888)

Also a commandment of the love of man.— There are cases in which a child would be a crime: in the case of chronic invalids and neurasthenics of the third degree. What should one do in such cases?— One might at least try encouraging them to chastity, perhaps with the aid of Parsifal music: Parsifal himself, this typical idiot, had only too many reasons not to propagate himself. The trouble is that a certain inability to “control” oneself (—not to react to stimuli, even to very slight sexual stimuli) is one of the most regular consequences of general exhaustion. One would be mistaken, for example, to think of a Leopardi as chaste. The priest, the moralist play a hopeless game in such cases; it would make more sense to go to a pharmacy. After all, society has a duty here: few more pressing and fundamental demands can be made upon it. Society, as the great trustee of life, is responsible to life itself for every miscarried life—it also has to pay for such lives: consequently it ought to prevent them. In numerous cases, society ought to prevent procreation: to this end, it may hold in readiness, without regard to descent, rank, or spirit, the most rigorous means of constraint, deprivation of freedom, in certain circumstances castration.— The Biblical prohibition “thou shalt not kill!” is a piece of naïveté compared with the seriousness of the prohibition of life to decadents: “thou shalt not procreate!”— Life itself recognizes no solidarity, no “equal rights,” between the healthy and the degenerate parts of an organism: one must excise the latter—or the whole will perish — Sympathy for decadents, equal rights for the ill-constituted—that would be the profoundest immorality, that would be antinature itself as morality!

97 735 (1887; rev. 1888) There are delicate and sickly inclined natures, so-called idealists, who cannot achieve anything better than a crime, cru, vert:98 it is the great justification of their little, pale existences, a payment for a protracted cowardice and mendaciousness, a moment at least of strength: afterwards they perish of it.99

736 (Spring-Fall 1887)

In our civilized world, we learn to know almost only the wretched criminal, crushed by the curse and the contempt of society, mistrustful of himself, often belittling and slandering his deed, a miscarried type of criminal; and we resist the idea that all great human beings have been criminals (only in the grand and not in a miserable style), that crime belongs to greatness (—for that is the experience of those who have tried the reins and of all who have descended deepest into great souls—). To be “free as a bird” from tradition, the conscience of duty—every great human being knows this danger. But he also desires it: he desires a great goal and therefore also the means to it.¹⁰⁰

737 (March-June 1888)

Ages in which one leads men with reward and punishment have a low, still primitive kind of man in view: it is as if they were children— Within our late culture, fatality and degeneration are something that completely abolishes all meaning of reward and punishment— This real determination of action through reward and punishment presupposes young, strong, forceful races. In old races, the impulses are so irresistible that a mere idea is quite powerless;—to be unable to offer resistance where a stimulus is given, but to have to respond to it: this extreme susceptibility of decadents renders such systems of punishment and improvement perfectly meaningless. * The concept “improvement” rests on the presupposition of a normal and strong man, whose individual action must in some way be balanced in order not to lose him [to the community],¹⁰¹ in order not to have him as an enemy.

738 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Effect of a prohibition.— Every power that forbids, that knows how to arouse fear in those to whom something is forbidden, creates a “bad conscience” (that is, the desire for something combined with the consciousness of danger in satisfying it, with the necessity for secrecy, for underhandedness, for caution). Every prohibition worsens the character of those who do not submit to it willingly, but only because they are compelled.

739 (March-June 1888)

“Reward and punishment.”— They stand together, they fall together. Today one does not want to be rewarded, one will not acknowledge the right of anyone to punish— One has put oneself on a war footing: one desires something, one meets with opposition, one can perhaps gain what one wants most reasonably if one gets along—if one draws up a contract. A modern society, in which every individual has drawn up his “contract”—the criminal breaks a contract— That would be a clear concept. But then one could not tolerate within a society anarchists and those who oppose the form of that society or principle—

740 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Crime belongs to the concept “revolt against the social order.” One does not “punish” a rebel; one suppresses him. A rebel can be a miserable and contemptible man; but there is nothing contemptible in a revolt as such—and to be a rebel in view of contemporary society does not in itself lower the value of a man. There are even cases in which one might have to honor a rebel, because he finds something in our society against which war ought to be waged—he awakens us from our slumber. If a criminal perpetrates an individual act against an individual this does not demonstrate that his whole instinct is not in a state of war with the whole order: his deed as a mere symptom. One should reduce the concept “punishment” to the concept: suppression of a revolt, security measures against the suppressed (total or partial imprisonment). But one should not express contempt through punishment: a criminal is in any case a man who risks his life, his honor, his freedom—a man of courage. Neither should one take punishment to be a penance; or as a payment, as if an exchange relationship existed between guilt and punishment—punishment does not purify, for crime does not sully. One should not deprive the criminal of the possibility of making his peace with society; provided he does not belong to the race of criminals. In that case one should make war on him even before he has committed any hostile act (first operation as soon as one has him in one’s power: his castration). One should not hold against the criminal his bad manners or the low level of his intelligence. Nothing is more common than that he should misunderstand himself (for often his rebellious instinct, the rancor of the *déclassé*, has not reached consciousness, *faute le lecture*),¹⁰² that he should slander and dishonor his deed under the influence of fear and failure—quite apart from those cases in which, psychologically speaking, the criminal surrenders to an uncomprehended drive and by some subsidiary action ascribes a false motive to his deed (perhaps by a robbery when what he wanted was blood).¹⁰³ One should beware of assessing the value of a man according to a single deed. Napoleon warned against this. For our *haut-relief* deeds are quite especially insignificant. If men like us have no crime, e.g., murder, on our conscience—why is it? Because a few opportune circumstances were lacking. And if we did it, what would that indicate about our value? In a way one would despise us if one thought we had not the strength to kill a man under certain circumstances. In almost all crimes some qualities also find expression which ought not to be lacking in a man. It was not without justification that Dostoevsky said of the inmates of his Siberian prisons that they formed the strongest and most valuable part of the Russian people.¹⁰⁴ If with us the criminal is an ill-nourished and stunted plant, this is to the dishonor of our social relationships; in the age of the Renaissance the criminal thrived and acquired for himself his own kind of virtue—virtue in the Renaissance style, to

be sure, virtù, moraline-free virtue. One can enhance only those men whom one does not treat with contempt; moral contempt causes greater indignity and harm than any crime. 741 (1883-1888) The derogatory element first entered into punishment when certain penalties became associated with contemptible men (e.g., slaves). Those punished most were contemptible men, and at length punishment came to contain something derogatory.

742 (March-June 1888)

In ancient penal law a religious concept was at work: that of the expiatory power of punishment. Punishment purifies: in the modern world it sullies. Punishment is a payment: one is really rid of that for which one was willing to suffer so much. Provided there is a belief in this power of punishment, there follows a profound sense of relief which is really very close to a new health, a restoration. One has not only made one's peace with society again, one has also regained one's self-respect and feels—"pure." Today punishment isolates even more than the crime; the fatality behind a crime has grown so great that it has grown incurable. One emerges from punishment as an enemy of society. From then on, it has one more enemy. *Jus talionis* can be dictated by the spirit of retribution (i.e., by a kind of moderation of the instinct for revenge); but with *Manu*, e.g., it is the need to possess an equivalent in order to expiate, in order to be "free" again in a religious sense. 743 (1885-1886) My rather radical question mark set against all modern penal codes is this: if the punishment should hurt in proportion to the magnitude of the crime—and fundamentally that is what all of you want!—you would have to measure the susceptibility to pain of every criminal. Does that not mean: a previously determined punishment for a crime, a penal code, ought not to exist at all? But considering that one would scarcely be able to determine a criminal's degrees of pleasure and displeasure, wouldn't one have to do without punishment in practice? What a loss! Isn't it? Consequently — 744 (1883-1888) Ah, the philosophy of right! A science that, like all moral science, has not even reached the cradle yet! One still misunderstands, e.g., even among jurists who think themselves enlightened, the oldest and most valuable significance of punishment—one does not know it at all; and as long as jurisprudence does not put itself on a new footing, namely on that of comparative history and anthropology, it will persist in the useless struggle between fundamentally false abstractions that today pass for "philosophy of right" and that are all based on contemporary man. This contemporary man, however, is so intricate, also in his legal evaluations, that he permits the most varied interpretations. 745 (1883-1888) An old Chinese said he had heard that when empires were doomed they had many laws.

746 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Schopenhauer wanted rascals to be castrated and silly geese to be shut up in convents: from what point of view would this be desirable? The rascal has this advantage over many other men, that he is not mediocre; and the fool has this advantage over us, that he does not suffer at the sight of mediocrity. It would be more desirable that the gulf should be made wider; so rascality and folly should increase. In this way human nature would be expanded— But, after all, this is dictated by necessity; it does not depend on whether we desire it or not. Folly, rascality increase: that is part of “progress.”

747 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

In contemporary society a great deal of consideration, of tact and forbearance, of good-natured respect for the rights of others, even for the claims of others, is quite widespread; even more, a certain benevolent instinctive estimation of human value in general, which finds expression in trustfulness and credit of all kinds. Respect for man—and not merely for virtuous men—is perhaps what divides us most sharply from a Christian evaluation. It seems to us ironic to a degree when we still hear morals preached; a man lowers himself in our eyes and becomes comical if he preaches morals. This moral liberality is one of the best signs of our age. When we discover cases in which it is noticeably lacking, this strikes us as a kind of sickness (the case of Carlyle in England, the case of Ibsen in Norway, the case of Schopenhauerian[?]106 pessimism[?] throughout Europe[?]). If anything can reconcile us to our age, it is the great amount of immorality it permits itself without thinking any the worse of itself. On the contrary! What constitutes the superiority of culture over unculture? of the Renaissance over the Middle Ages, for example?— One thing alone; the great amount of admitted immorality. From this it follows of necessity what all the heights of human evolution must represent to the eye of the moral fanatic: the non plus ultra of corruption (—consider Savonarola’s judgment of Florence, Plato’s judgment of Periclean Athens, Luther’s[?] judgment[?] of Rome, Rousseau’s judgment of Voltaire’s society, the German judgment contra Goethe).

748 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

A little fresh air! This absurd condition of Europe shall not go on much longer! Is there any idea at all behind this bovine nationalism? What value can there be now, when everything points to wider and more common interests, in encouraging this boorish self-conceit? And this in a state of affairs in which spiritual dependency and disnationalization meet the eye and in which the value and meaning of contemporary culture lie in mutual blending and fertilization!— And the “new Reich” again founded on the most threadbare and despised ideas: equal rights and universal suffrage. The struggle for advantage within a state of affairs that is no good; this culture of big cities, newspapers, feverishness and “pointlessness”—! The economic unification of Europe is coming of necessity— and also, as a reaction, a peace party— A party of peace, without sentimentality, that forbids itself and its children to wage war; forbids recourse to the courts; that provokes struggle, contradiction, persecution against itself: a party of the oppressed, at least for a time; soon the big party. Opposed to feelings of revenge and resentment. A war party, equally principled and severe toward itself, proceeding in the opposite direction—

749107 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

The princes of Europe should consider carefully whether they can do without our support. We immoralists—we are today the only power that needs no allies in order to conquer: thus we are by far the strongest of the strong. We do not even need to tell lies: what other power can dispense with that? A powerful seduction fights on our behalf, the most powerful perhaps that there has ever been—the seduction of truth—“Truth”? Who has forced this word on me? But I repudiate it; but I disdain this proud word: no, we do not need even this; we shall conquer and come to power even without truth. The spell that fights on our behalf, the eye of Venus that charms and blinds even our opponents, is the magic of the extreme, the seduction that everything extreme exercises: we immoralists—we are the most extreme. 750 (1884) The rotted ruling classes have ruined the image of the ruler. The “state” as a court of law is a piece of cowardice, because the great human being is lacking to provide a standard of measurement. Finally, the sense of insecurity grows so great that men cower in the dust before any forceful will that commands. N.B. Scorn for the kings with the virtues of petty virtuous people.¹⁰⁸

751 (March-June 1888)

“The will to power” is so hated in democratic ages that their entire psychology seems directed toward belittling and defaming it. The type of the great ambitious man who thirsts after honor is supposed to be Napoleon! And Caesar! And Alexander!—As if these were not precisely the great despisers of honor! And Helvétius demonstrates to us that men strive after power so as to possess the enjoyments available to the powerful: he understands this striving for power as will to enjoyment! as hedonism! 752 (1884) According to whether a people feels “right, vision, the gift of leadership, etc., belong to the few” or “to the many”—there will be an oligarchic or a democratic government. Monarchy represents the belief in one man who is utterly superior, a leader, savior, demigod. Aristocracy represents the belief in an elite humanity and higher caste. Democracy represents the disbelief in great human beings and an elite society: “Everyone is equal to everyone else.” “At bottom we are one and all self-seeking cattle and mob.” 753 (1885) I am opposed to 1. socialism, because it dreams quite naively of “the good, true, and beautiful” and of “equal rights” (—anarchism also desires the same ideal, but in a more brutal fashion); 2. parliamentary government and the press, because these are the means by which the herd animal becomes master. 754 (1884) The arming of the people—is ultimately the arming of the mob. 755 (1884) How ludicrous I find the socialists, with their nonsensical optimism concerning the “good man,” who is waiting to appear from behind the scenes if only one would abolish the old “order” and set all the “natural drives” free. And the party opposed to them is just as ludicrous, because it does not admit the element of violence in the law, the severity and egoism in every kind of authority. “‘I and my kind’ want to rule and survive; whoever degenerates will be expelled or destroyed”—this is the basic feeling behind every ancient legislation. The idea of a higher kind of man is hated more than monarchs. Anti-aristocratic: that assumes hatred of monarchy only as a mask— 756 (1885-1886) How treacherous all parties are!—they bring to light something about their leaders which the latter have perhaps always taken great care to hide under a bushel. 757 (1884) Modern socialism wants to create the secular counterpart to Jesuitism: everyone a perfect instrument. But the purpose, the wherefore? has not yet been ascertained.

758 (Summer-Fall 1883)

Slavery today: a piece of barbarism! Where are those for whom they work? One must not always expect the contemporaneity of the two complementary castes. Utility and pleasure are slave theories of life: the “blessing of work” is the self-glorification of slaves.— Incapacity for otium.¹⁰⁹

759 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

One has no right to existence or to work, to say nothing of a right to “happiness”: the individual human being is in precisely the same case as the lowest worm.

760 (Fall 1888)

We must think of the masses as unsentimentally as we think of nature: they preserve the species. 761 (1885-1886) To look upon the distress of the masses with an ironic melancholy: they want something we are capable of—ah! 762 (1885) European democracy represents a release of forces only to a very small degree. It is above all a release of laziness, of weariness, of weakness.

763 (Spring-Fall 1887)

From the future of the worker.¹¹⁰— Workers should learn to feel like soldiers. An honorarium, an income, but no pay! No relation between payment and achievement! But the individual, each according to his kind, should be so placed that he can achieve the highest that lies in his power. 764 (1882) The workers shall live one day as the bourgeois do now—but above them, distinguished by their freedom from wants, the higher caste: that is to say, poorer and simpler, but in possession of power. For lower men the reverse valuation obtains; it is a question of implanting “virtues” in them. Absolute commands; terrible means of compulsion; to tear them away from the easy life. The others may obey; and their vanity demands that they appear to be dependent, not on great men, but on “principles.”

765 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

“Redemption from all guilt” One speaks of the “profound injustice” of the social pact; as if the fact that this man is born in favorable circumstances, that in unfavorable ones, were in itself an injustice; or even that it is unjust that this man should be born with these qualities, that man with those. Among the most honest of these opponents of society it is asserted: “we ourselves, with all our bad, sick, criminal qualities, which we admit to, are only the inescapable consequences of a long suppression of the weak by the strong”; they make the ruling classes responsible for their characters. And they threaten, they rage, they curse; they become virtuous from indignation—they do not want to have become bad men, canaille, for nothing. This pose, an invention of the last few decades, is also called pessimism, as I hear; the pessimism of indignation. Here the claim is made to judge history, to divest it of its fatality, to discover responsibility behind it, guilty men in it. For this is the rub: one needs guilty men. The underprivileged, the decadents of all kinds are in revolt on account of themselves and need victims so as not to quench their thirst for destruction by destroying themselves (—which would perhaps be reasonable). To this end, they need an appearance of justice, i.e., a theory through which they can shift the responsibility for their existence, for their being thus and thus, on to some sort of scapegoat. This scapegoat can be God— in Russia there is no lack of such atheists from resentment—or the social order, or education and training, or the Jews, or the nobility, or those who have turned out well in any way. “It is a crime to be born in favorable circumstances; for thus one has disinherited the others, pushed them aside, condemned them to vice, even to work— How can I help it that I am wretched! But somebody must be responsible, otherwise it would be unberable!” In short, the pessimism of indignation invents responsibility in order to create a pleasant feeling for itself—revenge—“Sweeter than honey” old Homer called it. — * That such a theory is no longer rightly understood, that is to say despised, is a consequence of the bit of Christianity that we all still have in our blood; so we are tolerant toward things merely because they smell somewhat Christian from a distance— The socialists appeal to the Christian instincts, that is their most subtle piece of shrewdness. Christianity has accustomed us to the superstitious concept of the “soul,” the “immortal soul,” soul-monads that really are at home somewhere else and have only by chance fallen, as it were into this or that condition, into the “earthly” and become “flesh”; but their essence is not held to be affected, to say nothing of being conditioned, by all this. Social, family, historical circumstances are for the soul only incidental, perhaps embarrassments; in any event, it is not produced by them. With this idea, the individual is made transcendent; as a result, he can attribute a senseless importance to himself. In fact, it was Christianity that first invited the individual

to play the judge of everything and everyone; megalomania almost became a duty: one has to enforce eternal rights against everything temporal and conditioned! What of the state! What of society! What of historical laws! What of physiology! What speaks here is something beyond becoming, something unchanging throughout history, something immortal, something divine: a soul! Another Christian concept, no less crazy, has passed even more deeply into the tissue of modernity: the concept of the “equality of souls before God.” This concept furnishes the prototype of all theories of equal rights: mankind was first taught to stammer the proposition of equality in a religious context, and only later was it made into morality: no wonder that man ended by taking it seriously, taking it practically!—that is to say, politically, democratically, socialistically, in the spirit of the pessimism of indignation. * Wherever responsibilities have been sought it was the instinct of revenge that sought. This instinct of revenge has so mastered mankind in the course of millennia that the whole of metaphysics, psychology, conception of history, but above all morality, is impregnated with it. As far as man has thought, he has introduced the bacillus of revenge into things. He has made even God ill with it, he has deprived existence in general of its innocence; namely, by tracing back every state of being thus and thus to a will, an intention, a responsible act. The entire doctrine of the will, this most fateful falsification in psychology hitherto, was essentially invented for the sake of punishment. It was the social utility of punishment that guaranteed this concept its dignity, its power, its truth. The originators of this psychology—the psychology of will—are to be sought in the classes that administered the penal law, above all among the priests at the head of the oldest communality: they wanted to create for themselves a right to take revenge—they wanted to create a right for God to take revenge. To this end, man was conceived of as “free”; to this end, every action had to be conceived of as willed, the origin of every action as conscious. But these sentences refute the old psychology.¹¹¹ Today, when Europe seems to have entered upon the opposite course, when we halcyonians especially are trying with all our might to withdraw, banish, and extinguish the concepts of guilt and punishment from the world, when our most serious endeavor is to purify psychology, morality, history, nature, social institutions and sanctions, and even God of this filth—whom must we recognize as our most natural antagonists? Precisely those apostles of revenge and resentment, those pessimists from indignation par excellence, who make it their mission to sanctify their filth under the name of “indignation.” We others, who desire to restore innocence to becoming, would like to be the missionaries of a cleaner idea: that no one has given man his qualities, neither God, nor society, nor his parents and ancestors, nor he himself—that no one is to blame for him. There is no being that could be held responsible for the fact that anyone exists at all, that anyone is thus and thus, that anyone was born in certain circumstances, in a certain

environment.— It is a tremendous restorative that such a being is lacking. We are not the result of an eternal intention, a will, a wish: we are not the product of an attempt to achieve an “ideal of perfection” or an “ideal of happiness” or an “ideal of virtue”—any more than we are a blunder on the part of God that must frighten even him (an idea with which, as is well known, the Old Testament begins).

There is no place, no purpose, no meaning, on which we can shift the responsibility for our being, for our being thus and thus. Above all: no one could do it; one cannot judge, measure, compare the whole, to say nothing of denying it! Why not?— For five reasons, all accessible even to modest intellects; for example, because nothing exists besides the whole— And, to say it again, this is a tremendous restorative; this constitutes the innocence of all existence.112 766 (1886-1887) Basic error: to place the goal in the herd and not in single individuals! The herd is a means, no more! But now one is attempting to understand the herd as an individual and to ascribe to it a higher rank than to the individual—profound misunderstanding! ! ! Also to characterize that which makes herdlike, sympathy, as the more valuable side of our nature! 767 (1883-1888) The individual is something quite new which creates new things, something absolute; all his acts are entirely his own. Ultimately, the individual derives the values of his acts from himself; because he has to interpret in a quite individual way even the words he has inherited. His interpretation of a formula at least is personal, even if he does not create a formula: as an interpreter he is still creative. 768 (1882) The “ego” subdues and kills: it operates like an organic cell: it is a robber and violent. It wants to regenerate itself—pregnancy. It wants to give birth to its god and see all mankind at his feet.

769 (Fall 1888)

Every living thing reaches out as far from itself with its force as it can, and overwhelms what is weaker: thus it takes pleasure in itself. The increasing “humanizing” of this tendency consists in this, that there is an ever subtler sense of how hard it is really to incorporate another: while a crude injury done him certainly demonstrates our power over him, it at the same time estranges his will from us even more—and thus makes him less easy to subjugate.

770 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The degree of resistance that must be continually overcome in order to remain on top is the measure of freedom, whether for individuals or for societies—freedom understood, that is, as positive power, as will to power. According to this concept, the highest form of individual freedom, of sovereignty, would in all probability emerge not five steps from its opposite,¹¹³ where the danger of slavery hangs over existence like a hundred swords of Damocles. Look at history from this viewpoint: the ages in which the “individual” achieves such ripe perfection, i.e., freedom, and the classic type of the sovereign man is attained—oh no! they have never been humane ages! One must have no choice: either on top—or underneath, like a worm, mocked, annihilated, trodden upon. One must oppose tyrants to become a tyrant, i.e., free. It is no small advantage to live under a hundred swords of Damocles: that way one learns to dance, one attains “freedom of movement.” 771 (1883-1888) Man, more than any animal, originally altruistic: hence his slow development (child) and lofty culture; hence, too, his extraordinary, ultimate kind of egoism.—Beasts of prey are much more individual.

772 (Spring-Fall 1880)

[Critique of “selfishness”—]114 The involuntary naiveté of La Rochefoucauld, who thought he was saying something bold, free and paradoxical—in those days “truth” in psychological matters was something that aroused astonishment—

Example: “les grandes âmes ne sont pas celles qui ont moins de passions et plus de vertus que les âmes communes, mais seulement celles qui ont de plus grands desseins.”115— To be sure, John Stuart Mill (who calls Chamfort the nobler and more philosophical La Rouchefoucauld of the eighteenth century—) sees in him only an astute observer of all that in the human breast that derives from “habitual selfishness,” and adds: “a noble spirit will be unable to convince himself of the need to impose upon himself a constant contemplation of commonness and baseness, unless it were to show over what corrupting influences a lofty mind and nobility of character are able to triumph.”

773 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Morphology of self-esteem First viewpoint: to what extent feelings of sympathy and community are the lower, preparatory stage at a time when personal self-esteem and individual initiative in evaluation are not yet possible. Second viewpoint: to what extent the height of collective self-esteem, pride in the distinction of the clan, the feeling of inequality, the aversion to mediation, equality of rights, reconciliation, is a school for individual self-reliance; that is, in so far as it compels the individual to represent the pride of the whole: he has to speak and act with extreme respect for himself in so far as he represents the community in his own person. Also when the individual feels like the instrument and mouthpiece of the deity. Third viewpoint: to what extent these forms of depersonalization in fact give the person a tremendous importance, in so far as higher powers employ him; religious awe before oneself the condition of the prophet and poet. Fourth viewpoint: to what extent responsibility for the whole trains the individual to, and permits him, a broad view, a stern and terrible hand, a circumspection and coolness, a grandeur of bearing and gesture, which he would not permit himself on his own behalf. In summa: collective self-esteem is the great preparatory school for personal sovereignty. The noble class is that which inherits this training. 774 (1883-1888) The disguised forms of the will to power: Desire for freedom, independence, also for equilibrium, peace, co-ordination. Also the hermit, "spiritual freedom." In the lowest form: will to exist at all, "the drive to self-preservation." Enrollment, so as to satisfy the will to power in a larger whole: submission, making oneself indispensable and useful to those in power; love, as a secret path to the heart of the more powerful—so as to dominate him. The sense of duty, conscience, the imaginary consolation of outranking those who actually possess power; the recognition of an order of rank that permits judgment even of the more powerful; self-condemnation; the invention of new tables of value (Jews: classical example).

775 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Praise and gratitude as will to power.¹¹⁶— Praise and gratitude on the occasions of harvest, good weather, victory, marriage, peace:—all these festivals require a subject upon which the feeling can be discharged. One desires that all good things that happen to one should have been done to one: one desires a doer. The same applies to works of art. one is not satisfied with them alone: one praises the doer. What, then is praise? A sort of restoration of balance in respect of benefits received, a giving in return, a demonstration of our power—for those who praise affirm, judge, evaluate, pass sentence: they claim the right of being able to affirm, of being able to dispense honors. A heightened feeling of happiness and life is also a heightened feeling of power: it is from this that man praises (—from this that he invents and seeks a doer, a “subject”—). Gratitude as virtuous revenge: most strenuously demanded and practiced where equality and pride must both be upheld, where revenge is practiced best.

776 (Spring-Fall 1887)

On the “Machiavellianism” of Power The will to power appears a. among the oppressed, among slaves of all kinds, as will to “freedom”: merely getting free seems to be the goal (religiomorally: “responsible to one’s own conscience alone”; “evangelical freedom,” etc.); b. among a stronger kind of man, getting ready for power, as will to overpower; if it is at first unsuccessful, then it limits itself to the will to “justice,” i.e., to the same measure of rights as the ruling type possesses; c. among the strongest, richest, most independent, most courageous, as “love of mankind,” of “the people,” of the gospel, of truth, God; as sympathy; “self-sacrifice,” etc.; as overpowering, bearing away with oneself, taking into one’s service, as instinctive self-involvement with a great quantum of power to which one is able to give direction: the hero, the prophet, the Caesar, the savior, the shepherd; (—sexual love, too, belongs here: it desires to overpower, to take possession, and it appears as self-surrender. Fundamentally it is only love of one’s “instrument,” of one’s “steed”—the conviction that this or that belongs to one because one is in a position to use it). “Freedom,” “justice,” and “love”!!!

777 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Love.— Look into it; women's love and sympathy—is there anything more egoistic?—And if they sacrifice themselves, their honor, their reputation, to whom do they sacrifice themselves? To the man? Or is it not rather to an unbridled urge?— These desires are just as selfish even if they please others and implant gratitude— To what extent this sort of hyperfetation of one valuation can sanctify everything else!!

778 (March-June 1888)

“Senses,” “passions.”— Fear of the senses, of the desires, of the passions, when it goes so far as to counsel us against them, is already a symptom of weakness: extreme measures always indicate abnormal conditions. What is lacking, or crumbling, here is the strength to restrain an impulse: if one’s instinct is to have to succumb, i.e., to have to react, then one does well to avoid the opportunities (“seductions”) for it. A “stimulation of the senses” is a seduction only for those whose system is too easily moved and influenced: in the opposite case, that of a system of great slowness and severity, strong stimuli are needed to set the functions going. Excess is a reproach only against those who have no right to it; and almost all the passions have been brought into ill repute on account of those who were not sufficiently strong to employ them—. One must understand that the same objections can be made to the passions as are made to sickness: nonetheless—we cannot do without sickness, and even less without the passions. We need the abnormal, we give life a tremendous choc by these great sicknesses. In detail, the following must be distinguished: the dominating passion, which even brings with it the supremest form of health; here the co-ordination of the inner systems and their operation in the service of one end is best achieved—but this is almost the definition of health! the antagonism of the passions; two, three, a multiplicity of “souls in one breast”:¹¹⁷ very unhealthy, inner ruin, disintegration, betraying and increasing and inner conflict and anarchism— unless one passion at last becomes master. Return to health— juxtaposition without antagonism or collaboration: often periodic, and then, as soon as an order has been established, also healthy. The most interesting men, the chameleons, belong here; they are not in contradiction with themselves, they are happy and secure, but they do not develop—their differing states lie juxtaposed, even if they are separated sevenfold. They change, they do not become.

779 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The quantity of the aim in its effect on the perspective of evaluation: the great criminal and the small one. The quantity of the aim that is wanted is also decisive for him who wills— whether he respects himself or feels dejected and miserable. — Then the degree of spirituality in the means in its effect on the perspective of evaluation. How different the philosophical innovator, experimenter and man of violence appears from the robber, barbarian and adventurer!— Appearance of “disinterestedness.” Finally, noble manners, bearing, courage, self-confidence— how they alter the valuation of that which is attained in this way! * Perspective of evaluation: Influence of the quantity (great, small) of the aim. Influence of the spirituality of the means. Influence of manners during the act. Influence of success or failure. Influence of the opposing forces and their value. Influence of that which is permitted and forbidden.

780 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The artifices for making possible actions, measures, affects that, from an individual standpoint, are no longer “allowable”—nor “in good taste”: that art “makes them tasteful to us” that allows us to enter such “estranged” worlds. historians show in what way they are right and reasonable; travels; exoticism; psychology; penal codes; madhouse; criminals; sociology; “impersonality” (so that, as media of a collective, we permit ourselves these affects and actions—council of judges, jury, citizen, soldier, cabinet minister, prince, association, “critic”—) gives us the feeling we are making a sacrifice—

781 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Preoccupation with itself and its “eternal salvation” is not the expression of a rich and self-confident type; for that type does not give a damn about its salvation—it has no such interest in happiness of any kind; it is force, deed, desire—it imposes itself upon things, it lays violent hands on things. Christianity is a romantic hypochondria of those whose legs are shaky. Wherever the hedonistic perspective comes into the foreground one may infer suffering and a type that represents a failure.

782 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The “growing autonomy of the individual”: these Parisian philosophers such as Fouillée speak of this; they ought to take a look at the race moutonnaire to which they belong! Open your eyes, you sociologists of the future! The individual has grown strong under opposite conditions; what you describe is the most extreme weakening and impoverishment of mankind; you even desire it and employ to that end the whole mendacious apparatus of the old ideal! you are so constituted that you actually regard your herd-animal needs as an ideal! A complete lack of psychological integrity! 783 (1885) The modern European is characterized by two apparently opposite traits: individualism and the demand for equal rights; that I have at last come to understand. For the individual is an extremely vulnerable piece of vanity: conscious of how easily it suffers, this vanity demands that every other shall count as its equal, that it should be only inter pares. In this way a social race is characterized in which talents and powers do not diverge very much. The pride that desires solitude and few admirers is quite beyond comprehension; a really “great” success is possible only through the masses, indeed one hardly grasps the fact any more that a success with the masses is always really a petty success: because *pulchrum est paucorum hominum*.¹¹⁹ All moralities know nothing of an “order of rank” among men; teachers of law nothing of a communal conscience. The principle of the individual rejects very great human beings and demands, among men approximately equal, the subtlest eye and the speediest recognition of a talent; and because everyone has some kind of talent in such late and civilized cultures—and therefore can expect to receive back his share of honor—there is more flattering of modest merits today than ever before: it gives the age a veneer of boundless fairness. Its unfairness consists in a boundless rage, not against tyrants and public flatterers even in the arts, but against noble men, who despise the praise of the many. The demand for equal rights (i.e., to be allowed to sit in judgment on everything and everyone) is anti-aristocratic. Equally strange to the age is the vanished individual, the absorption in a great type, the desire not to be a personality—which constituted the distinction and ambition of many lofty men in earlier days (the greatest poets among them); or “to be a city” as in Greece; Jesuitism, Prussian officer corps and bureaucracy; or to be a pupil and continuator of great masters—for which non-social conditions and a lack of petty vanity are needed.

784 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

Individualism is a modest and still unconscious form of the “will to power”; here it seems sufficient to the individual to get free from an overpowering domination by society (whether that of the state or of the church). He does not oppose them as a person but only as an individual; he represents all individuals against the totality. That means: he instinctively posits himself as equal to all other individuals; what he gains in this struggle he gains for himself not as a person but as a representative of individuals against the totality. Socialism is merely a means of agitation employed by individualism: it grasps that, to attain anything, one must organize oneself to a collective action, to a “power.” But what it desires is not a social order as the goal of the individual but a social order as a means for making possible many individuals: this is the instinct of socialists about which they frequently deceive themselves (—apart from the fact that, in order to prevail, they frequently have to deceive themselves). The preaching of altruistic morality in the service of individual egoism: one of the most common lies of the nineteenth century. Anarchism, too, is merely a means of agitation employed by socialism; by means of it, socialism arouses fear, by means of fear it begins to fascinate and to terrorize: above all—it draws the courageous, the daring to its side, even in the most spiritual matters. All this notwithstanding: individualism is the most modest stage of the will to power. * Once one has achieved a certain degree of independence, one wants more: people arrange themselves according to their degree of force: the individual no longer simply supposes himself the equal of others, he seeks his equals—he distinguishes himself from others. Individualism is followed by the formation of groups and organs; related tendencies join together and become active as a power; between these centers of power friction, war, recognition of one another’s forces, reciprocation, approaches, regulation of an exchange of services. Finally, an order of rank. N.B.:120 2. they enter into struggle with one another, they come to an agreement over “equality of rights” (—“justice” as an aim—); 3. once this is achieved, the actual inequalities of force produce an enhanced effect (because peace rules on the whole and many small quanta of force now constitute differences that formerly did not count). Now individuals organize themselves in groups; the groups struggle for privileges and predominance. Strife breaks out again in a milder form. One desires freedom so long as one does not possess power. Once one does possess it, one desires to overpower; if one cannot do that (if one is still too weak to do so), one desires “justice,” i.e., equal power.

785 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Correction of the concept “egoism.”— When one has grasped to what extent the concept “individual” is an error because every single creature constitutes the entire process in its entire course (not merely as “inherited,” but the process itself —), then the single creature acquires a tremendously great significance. Instinct speaks quite correctly here. Where this instinct weakens—where the individual seeks a value for himself only in the service of others, one can be certain that exhaustion and degeneration are present. An altruistic disposition, genuine and without tartuffery, is an instinct for creating at least a secondary value for oneself in the service of other egoisms. Usually, however, altruism is only apparent; a detour to the preservation of one’s own feeling of vitality and value.

786 (Spring-Fall 1887)

History of Moralization and Dismoralization First proposition: There are no moral actions whatsoever: they are completely imaginary. Not only are they indemonstrable (which Kant, e.g., admitted, and Christianity as well)—they are altogether impossible. Through a psychological misunderstanding, one has invented an antithesis to the motivating forces, and believes one has described another kind of force; one has imagined a *primum mobile* that does not exist at all. According to the valuation that evolved the antithesis “moral” and “immoral” in general, one has to say: there are only immoral intentions and actions. Second proposition: This entire distinction “moral” and “immoral” proceeds from the idea that moral as well as immoral actions are acts arising from free spontaneity—in short, that such a spontaneity exists, or in other words: that moral judgments in general relate only to one species of intentions and actions, those that are free. But this whole species of intentions and actions is purely imaginary; the world to which alone the moral standard can be applied does not exist at all:—there are neither moral nor immoral actions. * The psychological error out of which the antithetical concepts “moral” and “immoral” arose is: “selfless,” “unegoistic,” “self-denying”—all unreal, imaginary. False dogmatism regarding the “ego”: it is taken in an atomistic sense, in a false antithesis to the “non-ego”; at the same time, pried out of becoming, as something that is a being. The false substantialization of the ego: (in the faith in individual immortality) this is made into an article of faith, especially under the influence of religio-moral training. After this artificial separation of the ego, and the declaration that it exists in and for itself, one confronted a value antithesis that seemed irrefutable: the single ego and the tremendous non-ego. It seemed evident that the value of the single ego could lie only in relating itself to the tremendous “non-ego”—being subject to it and existing for its sake.—Here the herd instincts were decisive: nothing is so contrary to this instinct as the sovereignty of the individual. But if the ego is conceived as something in and for itself, then its value must lie in self-negation. Thus: 1. the false autonomy of the “individual,” as atom; 2. the herd valuation, which abhors the desire to remain an atom and regards it as hostile; 3. as a result: the individual overcome by moving his goal; 4. now there seemed to be actions that were self-negating: one wove a whole sphere of fantastic antitheses about them; 5. one asked: in what actions does man affirm himself most strongly? Around these (sexuality, avarice, lust to rule, cruelty, etc.) prohibition, hatred, and contempt were heaped: one believed there were unselfish drives, one condemned all the selfish ones, one demanded the unselfish; 6. as a result: what had one done? One had placed a prohibition upon all the strongest, most natural, indeed the only real drives—henceforth, in order to find an action praiseworthy, one had to deny the presence in it of such drives;—tremendous falsification in

psychologisms. Even any kind of “self-satisfaction” had first to be made possible by misunderstanding and construing oneself *sub specie boni*. Conversely: that species that derived its advantage from depriving man of his self-satisfaction (the representatives of the herd instinct; e.g., the priests and philosophers) became subtle and psychologically astute, so as to demonstrate how nonetheless selfishness ruled everywhere. Christian conclusion: “Everything is sin; even our virtues. Absolute reprehensibility of man. The unselfish action is not possible.” Original sin. In short: once man had made of his instincts an antithesis to a purely imaginary world of the good, he ended by despising himself as incapable of performing actions that were “good.” N.B. Christianity thus demonstrates an advance in the sharpening of psychological insight: La Rochefoucauld and Pascal. It grasped the essential equivalence of human actions and their equivalence of value in essentials (—all immoral). * Now one seriously set about the task of forming men in whom selfishness was dead:—priests, saints. And if one doubted the possibility of becoming “perfect,” one did not doubt that one knew what is perfect. The psychology of the saint, the priest, the “good man” naturally had to be purely phantasmagorical. One had declared the real motives of actions bad: in order still to be able to act at all, to prescribe actions, one had to describe as possible and as it were sanctify actions that are utterly impossible. With the falseness of one’s former slanders, one now honored and idealized. Rage against the instincts of life as “holy,” as venerable. Absolute chastity, absolute obedience, absolute poverty: the priestly ideal. Alms, pity, sacrifice,¹²¹ denial of beauty, of reason, of sensuality, a morose eye cast on all strong qualities one possessed: the lay ideal. * One advances: the slandered instincts, too, try to create a right for themselves (e.g., Luther’s Reformation: coarsest form of moral mendaciousness under the guise of “evangelical freedom”)—one rebaptized them with holy names; the slandered instincts try to prove themselves necessary for the existence of the virtuous instincts; one must *vivre, pour vivre pour autrui*:¹²² egoism as means to an end; one goes further, one tries to grant both the egoistic and the altruistic impulses a right to exist: equal rights for the one as for the other (from the standpoint of utility); one goes further, one seeks a higher utility in a preference of the egoistic viewpoint over the altruistic: more useful in relation to the happiness of the majority or the progress of mankind, etc. Thus: a preponderance of the rights of egoism, but under the perspective of extreme altruism (“collective utility for mankind”); one tries to reconcile the altruistic mode of action with naturalness, one seeks altruism in the foundations of life; one seeks egoism and altruism as equally founded in the essence of life and nature; one dreams of a disappearance of the antithesis in some future, when, owing to continual adaptation, egoism will at the same time be altruism; finally, one grasps that altruistic actions are only a species of egoistic actions—and that the degree to which one loves, spends oneself, proves the degree of individual

power and personality. In short, that when one makes men more evil, one makes them better—and that one cannot be one without being the other—At this point the curtain rises on the dreadful forgery of the psychology of man hitherto. * Consequences: there are only immoral intentions and actions;—the so-called moral ones must be shown to be immoral.¹²³ The derivation of all affects from the one will to power: the same essence. The concept of life:—in the apparent antithesis (of “good” and “evil”) degrees of power in instinct express themselves, temporary orders of rank under which certain instincts are held in check or taken into service.— Justification of morality: economical, etc. * Against the second proposition. Determinism: attempt to rescue the moral world by transporting it—into the unknown. Determinism is only a modus of permitting ourselves to juggle our evaluations away once they have no place in a mechanistically conceived world. One must therefore attack determinism and undermine it: and also dispute our right to a distinction between a world in itself and a phenomenal world. 787 (1883-1888) The absolute necessity of a total liberation from ends: otherwise we should not be permitted to try to sacrifice ourselves and let ourselves go Only the innocence of becoming gives us the greatest courage and the greatest freedom! 788 (1883-1888) To restore a good conscience to the evil man—has this been my unconscious endeavor? I mean, to the evil man in so far as he is the strong man? (Dostoevsky’s judgment on the criminals in prison should be cited here.) 789 (1885-1886) Our new “freedom.”— What a feeling of freedom there is in feeling as we freed spirits do, that we are not harnessed to any system of “purposes”! Likewise, that the concepts “reward” and “punishment” do not reside in the essence of things! Likewise, that the good and the evil action cannot be called good and evil in themselves, but only in the perspective of what tends to preserve certain types of human communities! Likewise, that our assessments of pleasure and pain have no cosmic, let alone a metaphysical, significance! (—that pessimism, the pessimism of Herr von Hartmann, who claims to put the pleasure and displeasure of existence itself on the scales, with his arbitrary incarceration in the pre-Copernican prison and field of vision, would be something retarded and regressive unless it is merely a bad joke of a Berliner.)

790 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Once one is clear about the “why?” of one’s life, one can let its How? take care of itself. It is itself a sign of disbelief in a Why, in purpose and meaning, a sign of a lack of will, if the value of pleasure and displeasure step into the foreground and hedonistic-pessimistic theories get a hearing; and renunciation, resignation, virtue, and “objectivity” may at least be a sign that what matters most is beginning to be defective. 791 (1885) Up to now there has not yet been any German culture. It is no objection to this statement that there have been great hermits in Germany (e g., Goethe); for these had their own culture. But like mighty, defiant, solitary rocks, they were surrounded by the rest of what was German as by their antithesis—a soft, marshy, insecure ground upon which every step from other countries made an “impression” and created a “form”: German culture was a thing without character, an almost limitless compliance. 792 (1885) Germany, rich in clever and well-informed scholars, has lacked great souls, mighty spirits, to such an extent and for so long that it seems to have forgotten what a great soul, a mighty spirit, is; and today mediocre and quite ill-constituted men place themselves in the market square almost with a good conscience and without any embarrassment and praise themselves as great men and reformers, as, e.g., Eugen Dühring does—indeed a clever and well-informed scholar, but one who nevertheless betrays with almost every word he says that he harbors a petty soul and is tormented by narrow, envious feelings; also that what drives him is not a mighty, overflowing, benevolent, spendthrift spirit—but ambition! But to lust after honors in this age is even more unworthy of a philosopher than it was in any previous age: today, when the mob rules, when the mob bestows the honors!

793 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

My “future”:—a rigorous polytechnic education. Military service; so that, on an average, every man of the higher classes would be an officer, whatever else he might be. IV. THE WILL TO POWER AS ART

794 (March-June 1888)

Our religion, morality, and philosophy are decadence forms of man. The countermovement: art. 795 (1885-1886)¹²⁴ The artist-philosopher. Higher concept of art. Whether a man can place himself so far distant from other men that he can form them? (—Preliminary exercises: (1) he who forms himself, the hermit; (2) the artist hitherto, as a perfecter on a small scale, working on material.) 796 (1885-1886) The work of art where it appears without an artist, e.g., as body, as organization (Prussian officer corps, Jesuit order). To what extent the artist is only a preliminary stage. The world as a work of art that gives birth to itself—— 797 (1885-1886) The phenomenon “artist” is still the most transparent:—to see through it to the basic instincts of power, nature, etc.! Also those of religion and morality! “Play,” the useless—as the ideal of him who is overfull of strength, as “childlike.” The “childlikeness” of God, *pais paizon*.¹²⁵

798 (March-June 1888)

Apollinian—Dionysian.¹²⁶— There are two conditions in which art appears in man like a force of nature and disposes of him whether he will or no: as the compulsion to have visions and as a compulsion to an orgiastic state. Both conditions are rehearsed in ordinary life, too, but weaker: in dream and in intoxication. But the same antithesis obtains between dream and intoxication: both release artistic powers in us, but different ones: the dream those of vision, association, poetry; intoxication those of gesture, passion, song, dance.

799 (March-June 1888)

In the Dionysian intoxication there is sexuality and voluptuousness: they are not lacking in the Apollinian. There must also be a difference in tempo in the two conditions— The extreme calm in certain sensations of intoxication (more strictly: the retardation of the feelings of time and space) likes to be reflected in a vision of the calmest gestures and types of soul. The classical style is essentially a representation of this calm, simplification, abbreviation, concentration—the highest feeling of power is concentrated in the classical type. To react slowly; a great consciousness; no feeling of struggle.

800 (March-June 1888)

The feeling of intoxication, in fact corresponding to an increase in strength; strongest in the mating season: new organs, new accomplishments, colors, forms; “becoming more beautiful” is a consequence of enhanced strength.¹²⁷ Becoming more beautiful as the expression of a victorious will, of increased co-ordination, of a harmonizing of all the strong desires, of an infallibly perpendicular stress. Logical and geometrical simplification is a consequence of enhancement of strength: conversely the apprehension of such a simplification again enhances the feeling of strength— High point of the development: the grand style. Ugliness signifies the decadence of a type, contradiction and lack of co-ordination among the inner desires—signifies a decline in organizing strength, in “will,” to speak psychologically. The condition of pleasure called intoxication is precisely an exalted feeling of power— The sensations of space and time are altered: tremendous distances are surveyed and, as it were, for the first time apprehended; the extension of vision over greater masses and expanses; the refinement of the organs for the apprehension of much that is extremely small and fleeting; divination, the power of understanding with only the least assistance, at the slightest suggestion: “intelligent” sensuality—; strength as a feeling of dominion in the muscles, as suppleness and pleasure in movement, as dance, as levity and presto; strength as pleasure in the proof of strength, as bravado, adventure, fearlessness, indifference to life or death— All these climactic moments of life mutually stimulate one another; the world of images and ideas of the one suffices as a suggestion for the others:—in this way, states finally merge into one another though they might perhaps have good reason to remain apart. For example: the feeling of religious intoxication and sexual excitation (—two profound feelings, co-ordinated to an almost amazing degree. What pleases all pious women, old or young? Answer: a saint with beautiful legs, still young, still an idiot). Cruelty in tragedy and sympathy (—also normally co-ordinated—) Spring, dance, music:— all competitions between the sexes—and even that Faustian “infinity in the breast.” Artists, if they are any good, are (physically as well) strong, full of surplus energy, powerful animals, sensual; without a certain overheating of the sexual system a Raphael is unthinkable— Making music is another way of making children; chastity is merely the economy of an artist—and in any event, even with artists fruitfulness ceases when potency ceases— Artists should see nothing as it is, but fuller, simpler, stronger: to that end, their lives must contain a kind of youth and spring, a kind of habitual intoxication.

801 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

The states in which we infuse a transfiguration and fullness into things and poetize about them until they reflect back our fullness and joy in life: sexuality; intoxication; feasting; spring; victory over an enemy, mockery; bravado; cruelty; the ecstasy of religious feeling. Three elements principally: sexuality, intoxication, cruelty—all belonging to the oldest festal joys of mankind, all also preponderate in the early “artist.” Conversely, when we encounter things that display this transfiguration and fullness, the animal responds with an excitation of those spheres in which all those pleasurable states are situated— and a blending of these very delicate nuances of animal well-being and desires constitutes the aesthetic state. The latter appears only in natures capable of that bestowing and overflowing fullness of bodily vigor; it is this that is always the *primum mobile*. The sober, the weary, the exhausted, the dried-up (e.g. scholars) can receive absolutely nothing from art, because they do not possess the primary artistic force, the pressure of abundance: whoever cannot give, also receives nothing “Perfection”: in these states (in the case of sexual love especially) there is naively revealed what the deepest instinct recognizes as higher, more desirable, more valuable in general, the upward movement of its type; also toward what status it really aspires. Perfection: that is the extraordinary expansion of its feeling of power, riches, necessary overflowing of all limits.

802 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Art reminds us of states of animal vigor; it is on the one hand an excess and overflow of blooming physicality into the world of images and desires; on the other, an excitation of the animal functions through the images and desires of intensified life;—an enhancement of the feeling of life, a stimulant to it. How can even ugliness possess this power? In so far as it still communicates something of the artist's victorious energy which has become master of this ugliness and awfulness; or in so far as it mildly excites in us the pleasure of cruelty (under certain conditions even a desire to harm ourselves, self-violation—and thus the feeling of power over ourselves). 803 (1883-1888) "Beauty" is for the artist something outside all orders of rank, because in beauty opposites are tamed; the highest sign of power, namely power over opposites; moreover, without tension:—that violence is no longer needed; that everything follows, obeys, so easily and so pleasantly—that is what delights the artist's will to power.

804 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Origin of the beautiful and ugly.¹²⁸—Biological value of the beautiful and the ugly.— That which is instinctively repugnant to us, aesthetically, is proved by mankind's longest experience to be harmful, dangerous, worthy of suspicion: the suddenly vocal aesthetic instinct (e.g., in disgust) contains a judgment. To this extent the beautiful stands within the general category of the biological values of what is useful, beneficent, life-enhancing—but in such a way that a host of stimuli that are only distantly associated with, and remind us only faintly of, useful things and states give us the feeling of the beautiful, i.e., of the increase of the feeling of power (—not merely things, therefore, but also the sensations that accompany such things, or symbols of them). Thus the beautiful and the ugly are recognized as relative to our most fundamental values of preservation. It is senseless to want to posit anything as beautiful or ugly apart from this. The beautiful exists just as little as does the good, or the true. In every case it is a question of the conditions of preservation of a certain type of man: thus the herd man will experience the value feeling of the beautiful in the presence of different things than will the exceptional or over-man. It is the perspective of the foreground, which concerns itself only with immediate consequences, from which the value of the beautiful (also of the good, also of the true) arises. All instinctive judgments are shortsighted in regard to the chain of consequences: they advise what is to be done immediately. The understanding is essentially a brake upon immediate reactions on the basis of instinctive judgments: it retards, it considers, it looks further along the chain of consequences. Judgments concerning beauty and ugliness are shortsighted (—they are always opposed by the understanding—) but persuasive in the highest degree; they appeal to our instincts where they decide most quickly and pronounce their Yes and No before the understanding can speak. The most habitual affirmations of beauty excite and stimulate each other; once the aesthetic drive is at work, a whole host of other perfections, originating elsewhere, crystallize around “the particular instance of beauty.” It is not possible to remain objective, or to suspend the interpretive, additive, interpolating, poetizing power (—the latter is the forging of the chain of affirmations of beauty). The sight of a “beautiful woman”— Thus 1. the judgment of beauty is shortsighted, it sees only the immediate consequences; 2. it lavishes upon the object that inspires it a magic conditioned by the association of various beauty judgments—that are quite alien to the nature of that object. To experience a thing as beautiful means: to experience it necessarily wrongly— (which, incidentally, is why marriage for love is, from the point of view of society, the most unreasonable kind of marriage). 805 (1883-1888) On the genesis of art.— That making perfect, seeing as perfect, which characterizes the cerebral system bursting with sexual energy (evening with the beloved, the

smallest chance occurrences transfigured, life a succession of sublime things, “the misfortune of the unfortunate lover worth more than anything else”); on the other hand, everything perfect and beautiful works as an unconscious reminder of that enamored condition and its way of seeing—every perfection, all the beauty of things, revives through contiguity a this aphrodisiac bliss.

(Physiologically: the creative instinct of the artist and the distribution of semen in his blood—) The demand for art and beauty is an indirect demand for the ecstasies of sexuality communicated to the brain. The world become perfect, through “love”— 806 (1883-1888) Sensuality in its disguises: (1) as idealism (“Plato”), peculiar to youth, creating the same kind of concave image that the beloved in particular assumes, imposing an encrustation, magnification, transfiguration, infinity upon everything—; (2) in the religion of love: “a handsome young man, a beautiful woman,” somehow divine, a bridegroom, a bride of the soul—; (3) in art, as the “embellishing” power: as man sees woman and, as it were, makes her a present of everything excellent, so the sensuality of the artist puts into one object everything else that he honors and esteems—in this way he perfects an object (“idealizes” it). Woman, conscious of man’s feelings concerning women, assists his efforts at idealization by adorning herself, walking beautifully, dancing, expressing delicate thoughts: in the same way, she practices modesty, reserve, distance—realizing instinctively that in this way the idealizing capacity of the man will grow. (—Given the tremendous subtlety of woman’s instinct, modesty remains by no means conscious hypocrisy: she divines that it is precisely an actual naive modesty that most seduces a man and impels him to overestimate her. Therefore woman is naive—from the subtlety of her instinct, which advises her of the utility of innocence. A deliberate closing of one’s eyes to oneself— Wherever dissembling produces a stronger effect when it is unconscious, it becomes unconscious.)

807 (Summer-Fall 1888)

What a tremendous amount can be accomplished by that intoxication which is called “love” but which is yet something other than love!— But everyone has his own knowledge of this. The muscular strength of a girl increases as soon as a man comes into her vicinity; there are instruments to measure this. When the sexes are in yet closer contact, as, e.g., at dances and other social events, this strength is augmented to such a degree that real feats of strength are possible: in the end one scarcely believes one’s own eyes—or one’s watch. In such cases, to be sure, we must reckon with the fact that dancing in itself, like every other swift movement, brings with it a kind of intoxication of the whole vascular, nervous, and muscular system. So one has to reckon with the combined effects of a twofold intoxication.— And how wise it is at times to be a little tipsy! There are realities that one may never admit to oneself; after all, one is a woman; after all, one has a woman’s pudeurs— Those young creatures dancing over there are obviously beyond all reality: they are dancing with nothing but palpable ideals; what is more, they even see ideals sitting around them: the mothers!— Opportunity to quote Faust— They look incomparably better when they are a little tipsy like that, these pretty creatures—oh, how well they know that, too. They actually become amiable because they know it. Finally, they are also inspired by their finery; their finery is their third intoxication: they believe in their tailors as they believe in their God—and who would dissuade them from this faith? This faith makes blessed! And self-admiration is healthy! Self-admiration protects against colds. Has a pretty woman who knew herself to be well dressed ever caught cold? Never! I am even assuming that she was barely dressed.¹²⁹

808 (March-June 1888)

Do you desire the most astonishing proof of how far the transfiguring power of intoxication can go?— “Love” is this proof: that which is called love in all the languages and silences of the world. In this case, intoxication has done with reality to such a degree that in the consciousness of the lover the cause of it is extinguished and something else seems to have taken its place—a vibration and glittering of all the magic mirrors of Circe— Here it makes no difference whether one is man or animal; even less whether one has spirit, goodness, integrity. If one is subtle, one is fooled subtly; if one is coarse, one is fooled coarsely; but love, and even the love of God, the saintly love of “redeemed souls,” remains the same in its roots: a fever that has good reason to transfigure itself, an intoxication that does well to lie about itself— And in any case, one lies well when one loves, about oneself and to oneself: one seems to oneself transfigured, stronger, richer, more perfect, one is more perfect— Here we discover art as an organic function: we discover it in the most angelic instinct, “love”; we discover it as the greatest stimulus of life—art thus sublimely expedient even when it lies— But we should do wrong if we stopped with its power to lie: it does more than merely imagine; it even transposes values. And it is not only that it transposes the feeling of values: the lover is more valuable, is stronger. In animals this condition produces new weapons, pigments, colors, and forms; above all, new movements, new rhythms, new love calls and seductions. It is no different with man. His whole economy is richer than before, more powerful, more complete than in those who do not love. The lover becomes a squanderer: he is rich enough for it. Now he dares, becomes an adventurer, becomes an ass in magnanimity and innocence; he believes in God again, he believes in virtue, because he believes in love; and on the other hand, this happy idiot grows wings and new capabilities, and even the door of art is opened to him. If we subtracted all traces of this intestinal fever from lyricism in sound and word, what would be left of lyrical poetry and music?— *L’art pour l’art* perhaps: the virtuoso croaking of shivering frogs, despairing in their swamp— All the rest Was created by love—

809 (March-June 1888)

All art exercises the power of suggestion over the muscles and senses, which in the artistic temperament are originally active: it always speaks only to artists—it speaks to this kind of a subtle flexibility of the body. The concept “layman” is an error. The deaf man is not a species of the man with good hearing. All art works tonically, increases strength, inflames desire (i.e., the feeling of strength), excites all the more subtle recollections of intoxication—there is a special memory that penetrates such states: a distant and transitory world of sensations here comes back. The ugly, i.e., the contradiction to art, that which is excluded from art, its No—every time decline, impoverishment of life, impotence, disintegration, degeneration are suggested even faintly, the aesthetic man reacts with his No. The effect of the ugly is depressing: it is the expression of a depression. It takes away strength, it impoverishes, it weighs down—The ugly suggests ugly things; one can use one’s states of health to test how variously an indisposition increases the capacity for imagining ugly things. The selection of things, interests, and questions changes. A state closely related to the ugly is encountered in logic, too: heaviness, dimness. Mechanically speaking, equilibrium is lacking: the ugly limps, the ugly stumbles: antithesis to the divine frivolity of the dancer. The aesthetic state possesses a superabundance of means of communication, together with an extreme receptivity for stimuli and signs. It constitutes the high point of communication and transmission between living creatures—it is the source of languages. This is where languages originate: the languages of tone as well as the languages of gestures and glances. The more complete phenomenon is always the beginning: our faculties are subtilized out of more complete faculties. But even today one still hears with one’s muscles, one even reads with one’s muscles. Every mature art has a host of conventions as its basis—in so far as it is a language. Convention is the condition of great art, not an obstacle—Every enhancement of life enhances man’s power of communication, as well as his power of understanding. Empathy with the souls of others is originally nothing moral, but a physiological susceptibility to suggestion: “sympathy,” or what is called “altruism,” is merely a product of that psychomotor rapport which is reckoned a part of spirituality (induction psycho-motrice, Charles Féré thinks). One never communicates thoughts: one communicates movements, mimic signs, which we then trace back to thoughts.

810 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Compared with music all communication by words is shameless; words dilute and brutalize; words depersonalize; words make the uncommon common.

811 (March-June 1888)

It is exceptional states that condition the artist—all of them profoundly related to and interlaced with morbid phenomena— so it seems impossible to be an artist and not to be sick. Physiological states that are in the artist as it were molded into a “personality” and that characterize men in general to some degree: intoxication, the feeling of enhanced power; the inner need to make of things a reflex of one’s own fullness and perfection; the extreme sharpness of certain senses, so they understand a quite different sign language—and create one—the condition that seems to be a part of many nervous disorders—; extreme mobility that turns into an extreme urge to communicate; the desire to speak on the part of everything that knows how to make signs—; a need to get rid of oneself, as it were, through signs and gestures; ability to speak of oneself through a hundred speech media—an explosive condition. One must first think of this condition as a compulsion and urge to get rid of the exuberance of inner tension through muscular activity and movements of all kinds; then as an involuntary co-ordination between this movement and the processes within (images, thoughts, desires)—as a kind of automatism of the whole muscular system impelled by strong stimuli from within —; inability to prevent reaction; the system of inhibitions suspended, as it were. Every inner movement (feeling, thought, affect) is accompanied by vascular changes and consequently by changes in color, temperature, and secretion. The suggestive power of music, its “suggestion mentale”;— the compulsion to imitate: an extreme irritability through which a given example becomes contagious—a state is divined on the basis of signs and immediately enacted— An image, rising up within, immediately turns into a movement of the limbs—a certain suspension of the will—(Schopenhauer!!!) A kind of deafness and blindness towards the external world—the realm of admitted stimuli is sharply defined. This is what distinguishes the artist from laymen (those susceptible to art): the latter reach the high point of their susceptibility when they receive; the former as they give—so that an antagonism between these two gifts is not only natural but desirable. The perspectives of these two states are opposite: to demand of the artist that he should practice the perspective of the audience (of the critic—) means to demand that he should impoverish himself and his creative power— It is the same here as with the difference between the sexes: one ought not to demand of the artist, who gives, that he should become a woman—that he should receive. Our aesthetics hitherto has been a woman’s aesthetics to the extent that only the receivers of art have formulated their experience of “what is beautiful?” In all philosophy hitherto the artist is lacking— This, as the foregoing indicates, is a necessary mistake; for the artist who began to understand himself

would misunderstand himself: he ought not to look back, he ought not to look at all, he ought to give.— It is to the honor of an artist if he is unable to be a critic — otherwise he is half and half, he is “modern.”

812 (March-June 1888)

I set down here a list of psychological states as signs of a full and flourishing life that one is accustomed today to condemn as morbid. For by now we have learned better than to speak of healthy and sick as of an antithesis: it is a question of degrees. My claim in this matter is that what is today called “healthy” represents a lower level than that which under favorable circumstances would be healthy—that we are relatively sick—The artist belongs to a still stronger race. What would be harmful and morbid in us, in him is nature——But one objects to us that it is precisely the impoverishment of the machine that makes possible extravagant powers of understanding of every kind of suggestion: witness our hysterical females. An excess of sap and force can bring with it symptoms of partial constraint, of sense hallucinations, susceptibility to suggestion, just as well as can impoverishment of life: the stimulus is differently conditioned, the effect remains the same— But the aftereffect is not the same; the extreme exhaustion of all morbid natures after their nervous eccentricities has nothing in common with the states of the artist, who does not have to atone for his good periods— He is rich enough for them: he is able to squander without becoming poor. As one may today consider “genius” as a form of neurosis, so perhaps also the artistic power of suggestion—and indeed our artists are painfully like hysterical females!!! But that is an objection to “today,” not to “artists.” Inartistic states: those of objectivity, mirroring, suspended will—(Schopenhauer’s scandalous misunderstanding when he took art for a bridge to the denial of life) — Inartistic states: among those who become impoverished, withdraw, grow pale, under whose eyes life suffers:—the Christian. 813 (1888) The modern artist, in his physiology next-of-kin to the hysteric, is also distinguished by this morbidity as a character. The hysteric is false—he lies from love of lying, he is admirable in every art of dissimulation—unless his morbid vanity plays a trick on him. This vanity is like a continual fever that requires narcotics and does not shrink from any self-deception, any farce, that promises momentary relief. (Incapacity for pride and the continual need for revenge for a deeply ingrained self-contempt—this is almost the definition of this kind of vanity.) The absurd irritability of his system, which turns all experiences into crises and introduces the “dramatic” into the smallest accidents of life, robs him of all calculability: he is no longer a person, at most a rendezvous of persons and now this one, now that one shoots forward with shameless assurance. Precisely for this reason, he is great as an actor: all these poor will-less people whom doctors study so closely astonish one with their virtuosity in mimicry, transfiguration, assumption of almost any desired character.

814 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

Artists are not men of great passion, whatever they may like to tell us and themselves. And this for two reasons: they lack any sense of shame before themselves (they observe themselves while they live; they spy on themselves, they are too inquisitive) and they also lack any sense of shame before great passion (they exploit it as artists). Secondly, however, their vampire, their talent, grudges them as a rule that squandering of force which one calls passion.— If one has a talent, one is also its victim: one lives under the vampirism of one's talent. One does not get over a passion by representing it: rather, it is over when one is able to represent it. (Goethe teaches otherwise; but here it seems that he wanted to misunderstand himself—from *delicatezza*.130)

815 (Summer-Fall 1888)

The rationale of life.— A relative chastity, a prudent caution on principle regarding erotic matters, even in thought, can belong to the grand rationale of life even in richly endowed and complete natures. This principle applies especially to artists, it is part of their best wisdom of life. Completely non-suspect voices have lent support to this opinion: I name Stendhal and Th. Gautier, also Flaubert. The artist is perhaps necessarily a sensual man, generally excitable, susceptible in every sense to stimuli, meeting the very suggestion of a stimulus halfway even from afar. This notwithstanding, he is on the average, under the pressure of his task, of his will to mastery, actually moderate, often even chaste. His dominant instinct demands this of him: it does not permit him to expend himself in any casual way. The force that one expends in artistic conception is the same as that expended in the sexual act: there is only one kind of force. An artist betrays himself if he succumbs here, if he squanders himself here: it betrays a lack of instinct, of will in general; it can be a sign of decadence—in any case, it devalues his art to an incalculable degree.¹³¹

816 (March-June 1888)

Compared with the artist, the appearance of the scientific man is actually a sign of a certain damming-up and lowering of the level of life (—but also of strengthening, severity, hardness, will power). To what extent falsity, indifference to truth and utility may be signs of youth, of “childishness,” in an artist— Their habitual manner, their unreasonableness, their ignorance about themselves, their indifference to “eternal values,” their seriousness in “play”— their lack of dignity; buffoon and god side by side; saint and canaille— Imitation as an instinct, commanding.— Artists of ascending life—artists of declining life: do they not belong to all phases?— Yes!¹³²

817 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

Would any link at all be missing in the chain of art and science if woman, if the works of women were missing? Admitting exceptions—they prove the rule—woman attains perfection in everything that is not a work: in letters, in memoirs, even in the most delicate handiwork, in short in everything that is not a *métier*—precisely because in these things she perfects herself, because she here obeys the only artistic impulse she has—she wants to please— But what has woman to do with the passionate indifference of the true artist, who assigns more importance to a sound, a breath, a heyday!¹³³ than to himself? who strains with every finger to reach his innermost secrets? who accords no value to anything that cannot become form (—that cannot surrender itself, make itself public—). Art as it is practiced by the artist—do you not grasp what it is: an attempt to assassinate all *pudeurs*?¹³⁴ Only in this century has woman ventured to turn to literature (—*vers la canaille plumière écrivassière* in the words of old Mirabeau): she dabbles in writing, she dabbles in art, she is losing her instincts. But why? if one may ask.

818 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

One is an artist at the cost of regarding that which all non-artists call “form” as content, as “the matter itself.” To be sure, then one belongs in a topsy-turvy world: for henceforth content becomes something merely formal—our life included. 819 (1883-1888) A sense for and a delight in nuances (—the real mark of modernity), in that which is not general, runs counter to the drive that delights and excels in grasping the typical: like the Greek taste of the best period. There is an overpowering of the fullness of life in it; measure becomes master; at bottom there is that calm of the strong soul that moves slowly and feels repugnance toward what is too lively. The general rule, the law, is honored and emphasized: the exception, conversely, is set aside, the nuance obliterated. The firm, powerful, solid, the life that reposes broad and majestic and conceals its strength—that is what “pleases”; i.e., that corresponds to what one thinks of oneself. 820 (1885) In the main, I agree more with the artists than with any philosopher hitherto: they have not lost the scent of life, they have loved the things of “this world”—they have loved their senses. To strive for “desensualization”: that seems to me a misunderstanding or an illness or a cure, where it is not merely hypocrisy or self-deception. I desire for myself and for all who live, may live, without being tormented by a puritanical conscience, an ever-greater spiritualization and multiplication of the senses; indeed, we should be grateful to the senses for their subtlety, plenitude, and power and offer them in return the best we have in the way of spirit. What are priestly and metaphysical calumnies against the senses to us! We no longer need these calumnies: it is a sign that one has turned out well when, like Goethe, one clings with ever-greater pleasure and warmth to the “things of this world”:— for in this way he holds firmly to the great conception of man, that man becomes the transfigurer of existence when he learns to transfigure himself.136

821 (March-June 1888)

Pessimism in art?— The artist gradually comes to love for their own sake the means that reveal a condition of intoxication: extreme subtlety and splendor of color, definiteness of line, nuances of tone: the distinct where otherwise, under normal conditions, distinctness is lacking. All distinct things, all nuances, to the extent that they recall these extreme enhancements of strength that intoxication produces, awaken this feeling of intoxication by association: the effect of works of art is to excite the state that creates art— intoxication. What is essential in art remains its perfection of existence, its production of perfection and plenitude; art is essentially affirmation, blessing, deification of existence— What does a pessimistic art signify? Is it not a contradictio?— Yes.— Schopenhauer is wrong when he says that certain works of art serve pessimism. Tragedy does not teach “resignation”— To represent terrible and questionable things is in itself an instinct for power and magnificence in an artist: he does not fear them— There is no such thing as pessimistic art— Art affirms. Job affirms.— But Zola? But the Goncourts?— The things they display are ugly: but that they display them comes from their pleasure in the ugly— It’s no good! If you think otherwise, you’re deceiving yourselves.— How liberating is Dostoevsky! 822 (1888) If my readers are sufficiently initiated into the idea that “the good man” represents, in the total drama of life, a form of exhaustion, they will respect the consistency of Christianity in conceiving the good man as ugly. Christianity was right in this. For a philosopher to say, “the good and the beautiful are one,” is infamy; if he goes on to add, “also the true,” one ought to thrash him. Truth is ugly. We possess art lest we perish of the truth.

823 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The moralization of the arts.— Art as freedom from moral narrowness and corner-perspectives; or as mockery of them. Flight into nature, where its beauty is coupled with frightfulness. Conception of the great human being. —Fragile, useless luxury souls, troubled even by a breath, “beautiful souls.” —To awaken deceased ideals in all their merciless severity and brutality, as the most magnificent monsters they are. —A joyful delight in the psychological insight into the sinuosity and unconscious play-acting of all moralized artists. —The falsity of art—to bring to light its immorality. —To bring to light “basic idealizing powers” (sensuality, intoxication, superabundant animality). 824 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. 1888)137 Modern counterfeiting in the arts: regarded as necessary, namely as corresponding to the most characteristic needs of the modern soul. One plugs the gaps of talent, even more the gaps in education, tradition, schooling. First: one seeks for oneself a less artistic public, which loves unconditionally (—and soon kneels down before the person). The superstition of our century, the superstitious belief in the “genius,” helps. Second: one harangues the obscure instincts of the dissatisfied, ambitious, self-disguised spirits in a democratic age: importance of poses. Third: one transfers the procedures of one art to the other arts, confounds the objectives of art with those of knowledge or the church or racial interests (nationalism) or philosophy—one pulls all the stops at once and awakens the dark suspicion that one may be a god. Fourth: one flatters women, sufferers, the indignant, one makes narcotics and opiates dominant in art, too. One tickles the cultured, readers of poets and ancient stories.

825 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The division into “public hall” and “private chamber”; in the former one has to be a charlatan today, in the latter one is determined to be a virtuoso and nothing more! The specific “genius” of our century spans this division, is great in both: the great charlatanry of Victor Hugo and Richard Wagner, but coupled with so much genuine virtuosity that they satisfied even the most refined artistic connoisseurs. Hence their lack of greatness: their perspective was continually changing, now directed to the coarsest demands, now to the most refined.

826 (Spring-Fall 1887)

False “intensification”: 1. in romanticism: this constant *Espressivo* is no sign of strength but of a feeling of deficiency; 2. picturesque music, so-called dramatic music, is above all easier (as is the brutal colportage and the enumeration of faits and traits in the naturalistic novel); 3. “passion” a matter of nerves and wearied souls; like the delight in high mountains, deserts, storms, orgies, and horrors— in the bulky and massive (e.g., on the part of historians); there actually exists a cult of orgies of feeling (—how does it happen that strong ages have an opposite need in art—a need for a realm beyond passion?) 4. preference for exciting material (erotica or socialistica or pathologica) : all signs that show for whom one is working today: for the overworked and absent-minded or enfeebled. One has to tyrannize in order to produce any effect at all.139

827 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Modern art as an art of tyrannizing—— A coarse and strongly defined logic of delineation; motifs simplified to the point of formulas; the formula tyrannizes. Within the delineations a wild multiplicity, an overwhelming mass, before which the senses become confused; brutality in color, material, desires. Examples: Zola, Wagner; in a more spiritual order, Taine. Thus: logic, mass and brutality. 828 (1883-1888) In regard to painters: tous ces modernes sont des poètes qui ont voulu être peintres. L'un a cherché des drames dans l'histoire, l'autre des scènes de moeurs, celui-ci traduit des religions, celui-là une philosophie.¹⁴⁰ One imitates Raphael, another the early Italian masters; landscape artists employ trees and clouds to make odes and elegies. No one is simply a painter; all are archaeologists, psychologists, theatrical producers of this or that recollection or theory. They enjoy our erudition, our philosophy. Like us, they are full and overfull of general ideas They like a form, not for the sake of what it is, but for the sake of what it expresses. They are sons of a scholarly, tormented, and reflective generation—a thousand miles removed from the old masters, who did not read and only thought of feasting their eyes. 829 (1888) Fundamentally, even Wagner's music is still literature, no less than the whole of French romanticism: the charm of exoticism (strange times, customs, passions), exercised on sentimental stay-at-homes. The delight of entering the vastly distant foreign prehistoric land, accessible only through books, and of finding the whole horizon painted with new colors and possibilities—— The intuition of yet more distant, unexplored worlds; disdain for the boulevards—— For nationalism, let us not deceive ourselves, is merely another form of exoticism—— Romantic musicians relate what exotic books have made of them: one would like to experience exotic things, passions after the Florentine and Venetian taste: in the end one contents oneself with seeking them in pictures—— The essential thing is the type of new desire, the wish to imitate and to experience the lives of others, disguise, dissimulation of the soul—— Romantic art is only a makeshift substitute for a defective "reality." The attempt to do new things: revolution, Napoleon. Napoleon, the passion of new possibilities of the soul, an expansion of the soul. Weariness of will; all the greater excesses in the desire to feel, imagine, and dream new things——consequence of the excesses one has experienced: hunger for excessive feelings—— Foreign literatures offered the strongest spices.

830 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Winckelmann's and Goethe's Greeks, Victor Hugo's orientals, Wagner's Edda characters, Walter Scott's Englishmen of the thirteenth century—some day the whole comedy will be exposed! it was all historically false beyond measure, but —modern.¹⁴¹

831 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Toward a characterization of national genius in relation to what is foreign and borrowed:— The English genius coarsens and makes natural everything it takes up; the French makes thin, simplifies, logicizes, adorns; the German confuses, compromises, confounds and moralizes; the Italian has made by far the freest and subtlest use of what it has borrowed, and introduced a hundred times more into it than it took out of it: as the richest genius which had the most to bestow.

832 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The Jews approached genius in the sphere of art with Heinrich Heine and Offenbach, this most gifted and high-spirited satyr, who as a musician clung to the great tradition and who is for those who have more than mere ears a real liberation from the sentimental and at bottom degenerate musicians of German romanticism.

833 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Offenbach: French music with the spirit of Voltaire, free, high-spirited, with a little sardonic grin, but bright, clever almost to the point of banality (—he does not use make-up—) and without the mignardise of morbid or blond-Viennese sensuality. 834 (1884) If one understands by artistic genius the greatest freedom under the law, divine frivolity, facility in the hardest things, then Offenbach has even more right to the name “genius” than Wagner. Wagner is heavy and ponderous: nothing is more foreign to him than moments of the most high-spirited perfection, such as this buffoon Offenbach achieves five or six times in almost every one of his buffooneries.¹⁴³ But perhaps one might understand something else by the word genius.¹⁴⁴— 835 (1885-1886) For the chapter “Music.”¹⁴⁵—German and French and Italian music. (Our lowest periods politically the most fruitful. The Slavs?)— The cultural-historical ballet: has overcome opera — Actors’ music and musicians’ music.— An error that what Wagner created was a form:—it was formlessness. The possibility of a dramatic construction has still to be discovered.— Rhythm. “Expression” at any cost.— In praise of Carmen.— In praise of Heinrich Schütz (and the “Liszt Society”)— Whorish instrumentation.— In praise of Mendelssohn: an element of Goethe in him and nowhere else! (just as another element of Goethe came to perfection in Rahel;¹⁴⁶ a third in Heinrich Heine.)¹⁴⁷

836 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Descriptive music; leave it to reality to be effective— All these kinds of art are easier, more imitable; the poorly gifted employ them. Appeal to the instincts; art with the power of suggestion.

837 (Spring-Fall 1887)

On our modern music — The decay of melody is the same as the decay of the “idea,” of dialectic, of freedom of the most spiritual activity—a piece of clumsiness and constipation that is developing to new heights of daring and even to principles;—finally, one has only the principles of one’s talents, one’s narrowmindedness of a talent. “Dramatic music” nonsense! It is simply bad music— “Feeling,” “passion” as surrogates when one no longer knows how to achieve an exalted spirituality and the happiness that attends it (e g, that of Voltaire). Technically, “feeling” and “passion” are easier—they presuppose much poorer artists. Recourse to drama betrays that an artist is more a master of false means than of genuine means. We have dramatic painting, dramatic lyrics, etc. 838 (1888) We lack in music an aesthetic that would impose laws on musicians and give them a conscience; we lack, as a consequence, a genuine conflict over “principles”—for as musicians we laugh at Herbart’s velleities in this realm as much as we do at Schopenhauer’s. In fact, this results in a great difficulty: we no longer know on what basis to found the concepts “model,” “mastery,” “perfection”—we grope blindly in the realm of values with the instinct of old love and admiration; we come close to believing “what is good is what pleases us”— It awakens my mistrust when Beethoven is everywhere quite innocently described as a “classicist”: I would strictly maintain that in the other arts one understands by a classicist an artist of the opposite type of Beethoven’s. But when even the complete and obvious disintegration of style in Wagner, his so-called dramatic style, is taught and honored as “exemplary,” as “mastery,” as “progress,” my impatience reaches its height. The dramatic style in music, as Wagner understands it, is the renunciation of style in general, on the presupposition that something else is a hundred times more important than music, namely the drama. Wagner can paint, he employs music for something other than music, he emphasizes poses, he is a poet; finally, he appealed to “beautiful feelings” and “heaving bosoms” like all artists of the theater—and with all this he won over the women and even those in need of culture: but what is music to women and those in need of culture! They have no conscience for art; they do not suffer when all the principal and most indispensable virtues of an art are trampled under foot and mocked for the benefit of secondary objectives (as *ancilla dramaturgica*) What is the point of extending the means of expression if that which expresses, art itself, has lost the law of its being! The picturesque pomp and power of tones, the symbolism of sound, rhythm, colors of harmony and disharmony, the suggestive significance of music, the whole sensuality of music which Wagner has brought into dominance—all this Wagner recognized in music, drew out of it, developed. Victor Hugo did something similar to language; but already today the French are asking themselves whether, in Hugo’s case, it

was not a corruption of language— whether, with the increase of sensuality in language, reason, spirituality, the profound obedience to law in language have not been depressed? That the poets in France have become sculptors, that the musicians in Germany have become actors and culture-mongers— are these not signs of decadence?

839 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

Today we have a musical pessimism, even among the non-musical. Who has not met him, who has not cursed him—the wretched youth who tortures his piano into cries of despair, who single-handed heaves forward the mud of the gloomiest gray-brown harmonies? This identifies one as a pessimist— But whether this also identifies one as a musician? I cannot be made to think so. The Wagnerian *pur sang* is unmusical; he succumbs to the elemental powers of music somewhat as a woman succumbs to the will of her hypnotist—and in order to be able to do this, he must not be made suspicious by a severe and subtle conscience in *rebus musicis et musicantibus*.¹⁵⁰ I said “somewhat as”—: but perhaps we have more than a metaphor here. Consider the means for producing effects that Wagner prefers to use (—and had for the most part to invent for himself): they are strangely similar to those with which a hypnotist achieves his effect (—his choice of tempo and tonal color for his orchestra; the repellent avoidance of logic and squareness in his rhythm; the lingering, soothing, mysterious, hysterical quality of his “endless melody”).— And is the condition to which the Lohengrin prelude, for example, reduces its hearers, especially women, essentially different from a somnambulistic trance?— I heard an Italian woman who had just listened to the prelude in question say, with those entranced eyes that Wagneriennes know how to affect: “*come si dorme con questa musica!*”¹⁵¹

840 (March-June 1888)

Religion in music.— How much unadmitted and even uncomprehended satisfaction of all religious needs is still to be found in Wagnerian music! How much prayer, virtue, unction, “virginity,” “redemption” speak through it!— That music may dispense with words and concepts—oh what advantage she derives from that fact, this cunning saint, who leads and seduces back to all that was formerly believed!— Our intellectual conscience has no need to feel ashamed—it remains outside—when some ancient instinct or other drinks with trembling lips from forbidden cups— This is shrewd, healthy and, in so far as it betrays shame at the satisfaction of the religious instinct, even a good sign— Underhand Christianity: type of the music of “Wagner’s final period.” 841 (March-June 1888)¹⁵² I distinguish between courage in the face of people, courage in the face of things, and courage in the face of paper. The latter was, e.g., the courage of David Strauss. I distinguish further between courage before witnesses and courage without witnesses: the courage of a Christian, of a believer in God in general, can never be courage without witnesses—this fact alone degrades it. I distinguish, finally, courage rooted in temperament and courage rooted in fear of fear: a particular instance of the latter type is moral courage. There should also be added courage from despair. Wagner possessed this kind of courage. His situation regarding music was, at bottom, desperate. He lacked the two things needed to make a good musician: nature and culture, a predisposition toward music and training and schooling in music. He possessed courage: he made a principle of what he lacked—he invented a style of music for himself. “Dramatic music,” as invented by him, is the music he was capable of making—Wagner’s limitations define this concept. And he was misunderstood!— Was he misunderstood?— Five-sixths of modern artists are in this position. Wagner is their savior; five-sixths is in any case the “lowest estimate.” In every instance in which nature has shown herself inexorable and in which on the other hand culture has remained accidental, tentative, dilettante, the artist turns instinctively—what am I saying?— enthusiastically to Wagner: “half did he drag him, half he sank,” as the poet says.¹⁵³

842 (March-June 1888)

“Music”—and the grand style.— The greatness of an artist cannot be measured by the “beautiful feelings” he arouses: leave that idea to females. But according to the degree to which he approaches the grand style, to which he is capable of the grand style. This style has this in common with great passion, that it disdains to please; that it forgets to persuade; that it commands; that it wills— To become master of the chaos one is; to compel one’s chaos to become form: to become logical, simple, unambiguous, mathematics, law—that is the grand ambition here.— It repels; such men of force are no longer loved—a desert spreads around them, a silence, a fear as in the presence of some great sacrilege— All the arts know such aspirants to the grand style: why are they lacking in music? No musician has yet built as that architect did who created the Palazzo Pitti— Here lies a problem. Does music perhaps belong to that culture in which the domain of men of force of all kinds has ceased? Does the concept grand style ultimately stand in contradiction to the soul of music—to the “woman” in our music?— I here touch upon a cardinal question: where does our entire music belong? The ages of classical taste knew nothing to compare with it: it began to blossom when the Renaissance world had attained its evening, when “freedom” had departed from morals and even from men:—is it part of its character to be counter-Renaissance? Is it the sister of the Baroque style, since it is in any case its contemporary? Is music, modern music, not already decadence?— Once before I pointed to this question: whether our music is not a piece of counter-Renaissance in art? whether it is not next-of-kin to the Baroque style? whether it has not grown up in contradiction to all classical taste, so that all ambitions to become classical are forbidden to it by its nature? The answer to this first-rank question of values would not remain in doubt if the proper inferences had been drawn from the fact that music achieved its greatest ripeness and fullness as romanticism—once again as a movement of reaction against classicism. Mozart—a delicate and amorous soul, but entirely eighteenth century, even when he is serious.— Beethoven the first great romantic, in the sense of the French conception of romanticism, as Wagner is the last great romantic—both instinctive opponents of classical taste, of severe style—to say nothing of “grand” style.

843 (March-June 1888)

Romanticism: an ambiguous question, like everything modern. The aesthetic states twofold. The full and bestowing as opposed to the seeking, desiring. 844 (1885-1886) A romantic is an artist whose great dissatisfaction with himself makes him creative—who looks away, looks back from himself and from his world. 845 (1885-1886) Is art a consequence of dissatisfaction with reality? Or an expression of gratitude for happiness enjoyed? In the former case, romanticism; in the latter, aureole and dithyramb (in short, art of apotheosis) : Raphael, too, belongs here; he merely had the falsity to deify what looked like the Christian interpretation of the world. He was grateful for existence where it was not specifically Christian. The moral interpretation makes the world unbearable. Christianity was the attempt to “overcome” the world by it; i.e., to negate it. In praxi, such a murderous attempt of insanity—an insane self-elevation of man above the world—resulted in making man gloomy, small, and impoverished: only the most mediocre and harmless type of man, the herd type, profited by it, was advanced by it, if you like. Homer as an artist of apotheosis; Rubens also. Music has not yet had one. The idealization of the man of great sacrilege (a sense of his greatness) is Greek; 154 depreciation, slandering, contempt for the sinner is Judeo-Christian. 846 (1885-1886) What is romanticism?— In regard to all aesthetic values, I now employ this fundamental distinction: I ask in each individual case “has hunger or superabundance become creative here?” At first sight, another distinction might seem more plausible—it is far more obvious—namely the distinction whether the desire for rigidity, eternity, “being” has been the cause of creation, or rather the desire for destruction, for change, for becoming. But both kinds of desire prove, when examined more closely, to be ambiguous and interpretable according to the scheme mentioned above, which, I think, is to be preferred. The desire for destruction, change, becoming can be the expression of an overfull power pregnant with the future (my term for this, as is known, is the word “Dionysian”); but it can also be the hatred of the ill-constituted, disinherited, underprivileged, which destroys, has to destroy, because what exists, indeed existence itself, all being itself, enrages and provokes it. “Eternalization,” on the other hand, can proceed from gratitude and love—an art of this origin will always be an art of apotheosis, dithyrambic perhaps with Rubens, blissful with Hafiz, bright and gracious with Goethe, and shedding a Homeric aureole over all things—but it can also be that tyrannic will of a great sufferer who would like to forge what is most personal, individual, and narrow—most idiosyncratic—in his suffering, into a binding law and compulsion, taking revenge on all things, as it

were, by impressing, forcing, and branding into them his image, the image of his torture. The latter is romantic pessimism in its most expressive form, whether as Schopenhauerian philosophy of will or as Wagnerian music.¹⁵⁵

847 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Whether behind the antithesis classic and romantic there does not lie hidden the antithesis active and reactive?—

848 (Spring-Fall 1887)

To be classical, one must possess all the strong, seemingly contradictory gifts and desires—but in such a way that they go together beneath one yoke; arrive at the right time to bring to its climax and high point a genus of literature or art or politics (not after this has already happened—); reflect a total state (of a people or a culture) in one's deepest and innermost soul, at a time when it still exists and has not yet been overpainted with imitations of foreign things (or when it is still dependent—); and one must not be a reactive but a concluding and forward-leading spirit, saying Yes in all cases, even with one's hatred. "Is the highest personal value not part of it?"— To consider perhaps whether moral prejudices are not playing their game here and whether great moral loftiness is not perhaps in itself a contradiction of the classical?¹⁵⁶— Whether the moral monsters must not necessarily be romantics, in word and deed?— Precisely such a preponderance of one virtue over the others (as in the case of a moral monster) is hostile to the classical power of equilibrium: supposing one possessed this loftiness and was nonetheless classical, then we could confidently infer that one also possessed immorality of the same level: possibly the case of Shakespeare (assuming it was really Lord Bacon).¹⁵⁷

849 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Future things.— Against the romanticism of great “passion.”— To grasp that a quantum of coldness, lucidity, hardness is part of all “classical” taste: logic above all, happiness in spirituality, “three unities,” concentration, hatred for feeling, heart, esprit, hatred for the manifold, uncertain, rambling, for intimations, as well as for the brief, pointed, pretty, good-natured. One should not play with artistic formulas: one should remodel life so that afterward it has to formulate itself. It is an amusing comedy at which we have only now learned to laugh, which we only now see: that the contemporaries of Herder, Winckelmann, Goethe, and Hegel claimed to have rediscovered the classical ideal—and at the same time Shakespeare!— And the same generation had meanly repudiated the French classical school! as if the essential things could not have been learned here as well as there!— But one desired “nature,” “naturalness”: oh stupidity! One believed that classicism was a kind of naturalness! To think through, without prejudice or indulgence, in what soil a classical taste can grow. Hardening, simplification, strengthening, making man more evil: these belong together. Logical-psychological simplification. Contempt for detail, complexity, the uncertain. The romantics in Germany do not protest against classicism, but against reason, enlightenment, taste, the eighteenth century. The sensibility of romantic-Wagnerian music: antithesis of classical sensibility. The will to unity (because unity tyrannizes—namely over the listener, spectator); but inability to tyrannize over oneself concerning the main thing—namely in regard to the work itself (omitting, shortening, clarifying, simplifying). Overwhelming through masses (Wagner, Victor Hugo, Zola, Taine).

850 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The nihilism of artists.— Nature cruel in her cheerfulness; cynical in her sunrises. We are enemies of sentimental emotions. We flee to where nature moves our senses and our imagination; where we have nothing to love, where we are not reminded of the moral semblances and delicacies of this northerly nature—and the same is the case in the arts. We prefer that which no longer reminds us of “good and evil.” Our moralistic susceptibility to stimuli and pain is, as it were, redeemed by a terrible and happy nature, in the fatalism of the senses and forces. Life without goodness. The benefit consists in the contemplation of nature’s magnificent indifference to good and evil. No justice in history, no goodness in nature: that is why the pessimist, if he is an artist, goes in historicis to those places where the absence of justice itself is revealed with splendid naiveté, where perfection comes into view—and also in nature, to those places where her evil and indifferent character is not disguised, where she exhibits the character of perfection— The nihilistic artist betrays himself in willing and preferring cynical history, cynical nature.

851 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

What is tragic?— On repeated occasions I have laid my finger on Aristotle's great misunderstanding in believing the tragic affects to be two depressive affects, terror and pity. If he were right, tragedy would be an art dangerous to life: one would have to warn against it as notorious and a public danger. Art, in other cases the great stimulant of life, an intoxication with life, a will to life, would here, in the service of a declining movement and as it were the handmaid of pessimism, become harmful to health (—for that one is “purged” of these affects through their arousal, as Aristotle seems to believe, is simply not true). Something that habitually arouses terror or pity disorganizes, weakens, discourages—and supposing Schopenhauer were right that one should learn resignation from tragedy (i.e., a gentle renunciation of happiness, hope, will to life), then this would be an art in which art denies itself. Tragedy would then signify a process of disintegration: the instinct for life destroying itself through the instinct for art. Christianity, nihilism, tragic art, physiological decadence—these would go hand in hand, come into predominance at the same time, assist one another forward—downward— Tragedy would be a symptom of decline. One can refute this theory in the most cold-blooded way: namely, by measuring the effects of a tragic emotion with a dynamometer. And one would discover as a result what ultimately only the absolute mendaciousness of a systematizer could misunderstand—that tragedy is a tonic. If Schopenhauer did not want to grasp this, if he posited a general depression as the tragic condition, if he suggested to the Greeks (—who to his annoyance did not “resign themselves”—) that they had not attained the highest view of the world—that is *parti pris*, logic of a system, counterfeit of a systematizer: one of those dreadful counterfeits that ruined Schopenhauer's whole psychology, step by step (—arbitrarily and violently, he misunderstood genius, art itself, morality, pagan religion, beauty, knowledge, and more or less everything).

852 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

The tragic artist.¹⁵⁹— It is a question of strength (of an individual or of a people), whether and where the judgment “beautiful” is applied. The feeling of plenitude, of dammed-up strength (which permits one to meet with courage and good-humor much that makes the weakling shudder)—the feeling of power applies the judgment “beautiful” even to things and conditions that the instinct of impotence could only find hateful and “ugly.” The nose for what we could still barely deal with if it confronted us in the flesh—as danger, problem, temptation—this determines even our aesthetic Yes. (“That is beautiful” is an affirmation.) From this it appears that, broadly speaking, a preference for questionable and terrifying things is a symptom of strength; while a taste for the pretty and dainty belongs to the weak and delicate. Pleasure in tragedy characterizes strong ages and natures: their non plus ultra is perhaps the *divina commedia*. It is the heroic spirits who say Yes to themselves in tragic cruelty: they are hard enough to experience suffering as a pleasure. Supposing, on the other hand, that the weak desire to enjoy an art that is not meant for them; what would they do to make tragedy palatable for themselves? They would interpret their own value feelings into it; e.g., the “triumph of the moral world-order” or the doctrine of the “worthlessness of existence” or the invitation to “resignation” (—or half-medicinal, half-moral discharges of affects à la Aristotle).¹⁶⁰ Finally: the art of the terrifying, in so far as it excites the nerves, can be esteemed by the weak and exhausted as a stimulus: that, for example, is the reason Wagnerian art is esteemed today. It is a sign of one’s feeling of power and well-being how far one can acknowledge the terrifying and questionable character of things; and whether one needs some sort of “solution” at the end. This type of artists’ pessimism is precisely the opposite of that religio-moral pessimism that suffers from the “corruption” of man and the riddle of existence—and by all means craves a solution, or at least a hope for a solution. The suffering, desperate, self-mistrustful, in a word the sick, have at all times had need of entrancing visions to endure life (this is the origin of the concept “blessedness”). A related case: the artists of decadence, who fundamentally have a nihilistic attitude toward life, take refuge in the beauty of form—in those select things in which nature has become perfect, in which she is indifferently great and beautiful—(—“Love of beauty” can therefore be something other than the ability to see the beautiful, create the beautiful; it can be an expression of the very inability to do so.) Those imposing artists who let a harmony sound forth from every conflict are those who bestow upon things their own power and self-redemption: they express their innermost experience in the symbolism of every work of art they produce—their creativity is gratitude for their existence. The profundity of the tragic artist lies in this, that his aesthetic instinct surveys the more remote consequences, that he

does not halt shortsightedly at what is closest at hand, that he affirms the large-scale economy which justifies the terrifying, the evil, the questionable—and more than merely justifies them. (I) The conception of the work that one encounters in the background of this book is singularly gloomy and unpleasant: no type of pessimism known hitherto seems to have attained to this degree of malevolence. The antithesis of a real and an apparent world is lacking here: there is only one world, and this is false, cruel, contradictory, seductive, without meaning—A world thus constituted is the real world. We have need of lies in order to conquer this reality, this “truth,” that is, in order to live—That lies are necessary in order to live is itself part of the terrifying and questionable character of existence. Metaphysics, morality, religion, science—in this book these things merit consideration only as various forms of lies: with their help one can have faith in life. “Life ought to inspire confidence”: the task thus imposed is tremendous. To solve it, man must be a liar by nature, he must be above all an artist. And he is one: metaphysics, religion, morality, science—all of them only products of his will to art, to lie, to flight from “truth,” to negation of “truth.” This ability itself, thanks to which he violates reality by means of lies, this artistic ability of man par excellence—he has it in common with everything that is. He himself is after all a piece of reality, truth, nature: how should he not also be a piece of genius in lying! That the character of existence is to be misunderstood—profoundest and supreme secret motive behind all that is virtue, science, piety, artistry. Never to see many things, to see many things falsely, to imagine many things: oh how shrewd one still is in circumstances in which one is furthest from thinking oneself shrewd! Love, enthusiasm, “God”—So many subtleties of ultimate self-deception, so many seductions to life, so much faith in life! In those moments in which man was deceived, in which he duped himself, in which he believes in life: oh how enraptured he feels! What delight! What a feeling of power! How much artists’ triumph in the feeling of power!—Man has once again become master of “material”—master of truth!—And whenever man rejoices, he is always the same in his rejoicing: he rejoices as an artist, he enjoys himself as power, he enjoys the lie as his form of power.—(II) Art and nothing but art! It is the great means of making life possible, the great seduction to life, the great stimulant of life. Art as the only superior counterforce to all will to denial of life, as that which is anti-Christian, anti-Buddhist, antinihilist par excellence. Art as the redemption of the man of knowledge—of those who see the terrifying and questionable character of existence, who want to see it, the men of tragic knowledge. Art as the redemption of the man of action—of those who not only see the terrifying and questionable character of existence but live it, want to live it, the tragic-warlike man, the hero. Art as the redemption of the sufferer—as the way to states in which suffering is willed, transfigured, deified, where suffering is a form of great delight. (III) One will see that in this book

pessimism, or to speak more clearly, nihilism, counts as “truth.” But truth does not count as the supreme value, even less as the supreme power. The will to appearance, to illusion, to deception, to becoming and change (to objectified deception) here counts as more profound, primeval, “metaphysical” than the will to truth, to reality, to mere appearance:—the last is itself merely a form of the will to illusion. In the same way, pleasure counts as being more primeval than pain: pain only as conditioned, as a consequence of the will to pleasure (of the will to become, grow, shape, i.e., to create: in creation, however, destruction is included). A highest state of affirmation of existence is conceived from which the highest degree of pain cannot be excluded: the tragic-Dionysian state. (IV) In this way, this book is even anti-pessimistic: that is, in the sense that it teaches something that is stronger than pessimism, “more divine” than truth: art. Nobody, it seems, would more seriously propose a radical negation of life, a really active negation even more than merely saying No to life, than the author of this book. Except that he knows—he has experience of it, perhaps he has experience of nothing else!—that art is worth more than truth. Already in the preface, in which Richard Wagner is invited as to a dialogue, this confession of faith, this artists’ gospel, appears: “art as the real task of life, art as life’s metaphysical activity —”¹⁶² 124 1911, p. 511: “Contemporaneous with the beginning of work on *Beyond Good and Evil*, and initially planned as the continuation of the preface. “Line 1: After The artist-philosopher’ the MS goes on: ‘(hitherto mentioned scientific procedure, attitude to religion and politics).’ “In the margin, this comment on the whole aphorism: ‘here belongs the sequence of rank of the higher men, which must be described.’ ” 125 A child playing. 128a Nietzsche uses the English term, as in *Genealogy* III, section 4. 131 1911, p. 512: “A second part of this aphorism, dealing with Richard Wagner, has been omitted.” This part will be found, in the facsimile pages, and in translation in the Appendix. 136 MS not in Nietzsche’s handwriting—evidently dictated by him—but then revised by his hand. 141 1911, p. 512: “Last line, another reading: ‘modern, true.’ ” 144 1911, p. 512: These lines were “taken from a note about Richard Wagner.” This note is included in the facsimile pages and in translation in the Appendix. “Squareness” in the preceding paragraph: *Quadratur*. All of these notes on Wagner should be compared with *The Case of Wagner*. 152 1911, p. 512: “From a larger draft used in *The Case of Wagner*.” Nietzsche’s repeated emphasis on the magnificent indifference of nature invites comparison with the conclusion of Camus’ *The Stranger*; indeed this whole section—and not only this section—may have left its mark on Camus. Note also Nietzsche’s frequent use of the word “absurd.” I. ORDER OF RANK 854 (1884) In the age of suffrage universel, i.e., when everyone may sit in judgment on everyone and everything, I feel impelled to re-establish order of rank.

855 (Spring-Fall 1887)

What determines rank, sets off rank, is only quanta of power, and nothing else.
856 (1885-1886) The will to power.— How those men would have to be constituted who took upon themselves this revaluation. Order of rank as order of power: war and danger the presupposition for a rank to retain the conditions of its existence. The grandiose prototype: man in nature—the weakest, shrewdest creature making himself master, subjugating the stupider forces.

857 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

I distinguish between a type of ascending life and another type of decay, disintegration, weakness. Is it credible that the question of the relative rank of these two types still needs to be posed?

858 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

What determines your rank is the quantum of power you are: the rest is cowardice. 859 (1883-1888) Advantage of detachment from one's age.— In a state of detachment from both movements, individualistic and collectivistic morality—for even the former does not recognize order of rank and would grant one the same freedom as all. My ideas do not revolve around the degree of freedom that is granted to the one or to the other or to all, but around the degree of power that the one or the other should exercise over others or over all, and to what extent a sacrifice of freedom, even enslavement, provides the basis for the emergence of a higher type. Put in the crudest form: how could one sacrifice the development of mankind to help a higher species than man to come into existence?— 860 (1884) Of rank. The terrible consequence of “equality”— finally, everyone believes he has a right to every problem. All order of rank has vanished. 861 (1884) A declaration of war on the masses by higher men is needed! Everywhere the mediocre are combining in order to make themselves master! Everything that makes soft and effeminate, that serves the ends of the “people” or the “feminine,” works in favor of suffrage universal, i.e., the dominion of inferior men. But we should take reprisal and bring this whole affair (which in Europe commenced with Christianity) to light and to the bar of judgment. 862 (1884) A doctrine is needed powerful enough to work as a breeding agent: strengthening the strong, paralyzing and destructive for the world-weary.¹ The annihilation of the decaying races. Decay of Europe.— The annihilation of slavish evaluations.— Dominion over the earth as a means of producing a higher type.— The annihilation of the tartuffery called “morality” (Christianity as a hysterical kind of honesty in this: Augustine, Bunyan).— The annihilation of suffrage universal; i.e., the system through which the lowest natures prescribe themselves as laws for the higher.— The annihilation of mediocrity and its acceptance. (The onesided, individuals— peoples; to strive for fullness of nature through the pairing of opposites: race mixture to this end).— The new courage—no a priori truths (such truths were sought by those accustomed to faith!), but a free subordination to a ruling idea that has its time: e.g., time as a property of space, etc.

863 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The concept “stronger and weaker man” reduces itself to the idea that in the first case a great deal of force is inherited—he is a summation—in the second, as yet little—(—inadequate inheritance, splintering of that which is inherited).

Weakness can be an inaugural phenomenon: “as yet little”; or a terminal phenomenon: “no more.” The starting point is where great force is, where force is to be discharged. The mass, as the sum of the weak, reacts slowly; defends itself against much for which it is too weak—of which it can make no use; does not create, does not advance. This in opposition to the theory that denies the strong individual and believes “the mass does it.” It is the same difference as between two separated generations: four or five generations may lie between the active agent and the mass—a chronological difference. The values of the weak prevail because the strong have taken them over as devices of leadership.

864 (March-June 1888)

Why the weak conquer. In summa: the sick and weak have more sympathy, are “more humane”—the sick and weak have more spirit, are more changeable, various, entertaining—more malicious: it was the sick who invented malice. (A morbid precociousness is often found in the rickety, scrofulous and tubercular —.) Esprit: quality of late races: Jews, Frenchmen, Chinese. (The anti-Semites do not forgive the Jews for possessing “spirit”—and money. Anti-Semites—another name for the “underprivileged.”) The sick and weak have had fascination on their side: they are more interesting than the healthy: the fool and the saint—the two most interesting kinds of man—closely related to them, the “genius.” The great “adventurers and criminals” and all men, especially the most healthy, are sick at certain periods in their lives:—the great emotions, the passions of power, love, revenge, are accompanied by profound disturbances. And as for decadence, it is represented in almost every sense by every man who does not die too soon:—thus he also knows from experience the instincts that belong to it:—almost every man is decadent for half his life. Finally: woman! One-half of mankind is weak, typically sick, changeable, inconstant—woman needs strength in order to cleave to it; she needs a religion of weakness that glorifies being weak, loving, and being humble as divine: or better, she makes the strong weak—she rules when she succeeds in overcoming the strong. Woman has always conspired with the types of decadence, the priests, against the “powerful,” the “strong,” the men—. Woman brings the children to the cult of piety, pity, love:—the mother represents altruism convincingly. Finally: increasing civilization, which necessarily brings with it an increase in the morbid elements, in the neurotic-psychiatric and criminal. An intermediary species arises: the artist, restrained from crime by weakness of will and social timidity, and not yet ripe for the madhouse, but reaching out inquisitively toward both spheres with his antennae: this specific culture plant, the modern artist, painter, musician, above all novelist, who describes his mode of life with the very inappropriate word “naturalism”—Lunatics, criminals, and “naturalists” are increasing: sign of a growing culture rushing on precipitately—i.e., the refuse, the waste, gain importance—the decline keeps pace. Finally: the social hodgepodge, consequence of the Revolution, the establishment of equal rights, of the superstition of “equal men.” The bearers of the instincts of decline (of resentment, discontent, the drive to destroy, anarchism, and nihilism), including the slave instincts, the instincts of cowardice, cunning, and canaille in those orders that have long been kept down, mingle with the blood of all classes: two, three generations later the race is no longer recognizable—everything has become mob. From this there results a collective instinct against selection, against privilege of all kinds, that is so powerful and self-assured, hard, and cruel

in its operation, that the privileged themselves actually soon succumb to it: whoever still wants to retain power flatters the mob, works with the mob, must have the mob on its side—the “geniuses” above all: they become heralds of those feelings with which one moves the masses—the note of sympathy, even reverence, for all that has lived a life of suffering, lowliness, contempt, persecution, sounds above all other notes (types: Victor Hugo and Richard Wagner) .— The rise of the mob signifies once again the ascendancy of the old values. Such an extreme movement in respect of tempo and means as our civilization represents, shifts men’s center of gravity: those men who matter most, who have, as it were, the task of compensating for the vast danger of such a morbid movement;—they will become procrastinators par excellence, slow to adopt, reluctant to let go, and relatively enduring in the midst of this tremendous change and mixture of elements. In such circumstances, the center of gravity necessarily shifts to the mediocre: against the dominion of the mob and of the eccentric (both are usually united), mediocrity consolidates itself as the guarantee and bearer of the future. Thus emerges a new opponent for exceptional men—or a new seduction. Provided they do not accommodate themselves to the mob and try to flatter the instincts of the “disinherited,” they will have to be “mediocre” and “solid.” They know: mediocritas is also aurea—indeed, it alone disposes of money and gold (—of all that glitters—)—And once more the old virtue, and the entire dated world of the ideal in general, gains a body of gifted advocates.— Result: mediocrity acquires spirit, wit, genius—it becomes entertaining, it seduces.³ * Result.— A high culture can stand only upon a broad base, upon a strong and healthy consolidated mediocrity. Science—and even art—work in its service and are served by it. Science could not wish for a better situation: it belongs as such to a mediocre kind of man—it is out of place among the exceptional—it has nothing aristocratic, and even less anything anarchistic, in its instinct. The power of the middle is, further, upheld by trade, above all trade in money: the instinct of great financiers goes against everything extreme—that is why the Jews are at present the most conserving power in our intensely threatened and insecure Europe. They can have no use for revolution, socialism, or militarism: if they desire and employ power, even over the revolutionary party, this is only a consequence of the aforesaid and not a contradiction. They need occasionally to arouse fear of other extreme tendencies— by demonstrating how much power they have in their hands. But their instinct itself is unswervingly conservative—and “mediocre”— Wherever there is power, they know how to be powerful; but the employment of their power is always in one direction. The honorable term for mediocre is, of course, the word “liberal.” * Reflection.— It is absurd to assume that this whole victory of values is antibiological: one must try to explain it in terms of an interest life has in preserving the type “man” even through this method of the dominance of the weak and underprivileged—:

otherwise, man would cease to exist?—Problem—— The enhancement of the type fatal for the preservation of the species? Why? History shows: the strong races decimate one another: through war, thirst for power, adventurousness; the strong affects: wastefulness—(strength is no longer hoarded, spiritual disturbance arises through excessive tension); their existence is costly; in brief—they ruin one another; periods of profound exhaustion and torpor supervene: all great ages are paid for— The strong are subsequently weaker, more devoid of will, more absurd than the weak average. They are races that squander. “Duration” as such has no value: one might well prefer a shorter but more valuable existence for the species.— It would remain to be proved that, even so, a richer yield of value would be gained than in the case of the shorter existence; i.e., that man as summation of strength acquires a much greater quantum of mastery over things if life is as it is— We stand before a problem of economics

865 (Spring-Fall 1887)

An attitude that calls itself “idealism” and that will not allow mediocrity to be mediocre, or woman to be woman!— No uniformity! Let us be clear how dearly a virtue is bought; and that virtue is not something of average desirability, but a noble madness, a beautiful exception, with the privilege of strong feelings—

866 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

The need to show that as the consumption of man and mankind becomes more and more economical and the “machinery” of interests and services is integrated ever more intricately, a countermovement is inevitable. I designate this as the secretion of a luxury surplus of mankind: it aims to bring to light a stronger species, a higher type that arises and preserves itself under different conditions from those of the average man. My concept, my metaphor for this type is, as one knows, the word “overman.” On that first road which can now be completely surveyed, arise adaptation, leveling, higher Chinadom, modesty in the instincts, satisfaction in the dwarfing of mankind—a kind of stationary level of mankind. Once we possess that common economic management of the earth that will soon be inevitable, mankind will be able to find its best meaning as a machine in the service of this economy—as a tremendous clockwork, composed of ever smaller, ever more subtly “adapted” gears; as an ever-growing superfluity of all dominating and commanding elements; as a whole of tremendous force, whose individual factors represent minimal forces, minimal values. In opposition to this dwarfing and adaptation of man to a specialized utility, a reverse movement is needed—the production of a synthetic, summarizing, justifying man for whose existence this transformation of mankind into a machine is a precondition, as a base on which he can invent his higher form of being. He needs the opposition of the masses, of the “leveled,” a feeling of distance from them! he stands on them, he lives off them. This higher form of aristocracy is that of the future.—Morally speaking, this overall machinery, this solidarity of all gears, represents a maximum in the exploitation of man; but it presupposes those on whose account this exploitation has meaning. Otherwise it would really be nothing but an overall diminution, a value diminution of the type man—a regressive phenomenon in the grand style. It is clear, what I combat is economic optimism: as if increasing expenditure of everybody must necessarily involve the increasing welfare of everybody. The opposite seems to me to be the case: expenditure of everybody amounts to a collective loss: man is diminished—so one no longer knows what aim this tremendous process has served. An aim? a new aim?—that is what humanity needs.

867 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Insight into the increase of overall power: to calculate to what extent even the decline of individuals, of classes, of ages, of peoples is included in this growth. Shifting of the center of gravity of a culture. The cost of every great growth: who bears it! Why it must now be tremendous.

868 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Overall view of the future European: the most intelligent slave animals, very indutrsious, fundamentally very modest, inquisitive to excess, multifarious, pampered, weak of will—a cosmopolitan chaos of affects and intelligence. How could a stronger species raise itself out of him? A species with classical taste? Classical taste: this means will to simplification, strengthening, to visible happiness, to the terrible, the courage of psychological nakedness (—simplification is a consequence of the will to strengthening; allowing happiness to become visible, also nakedness, a consequence of the will to be terrible—). To fight upward out of that chaos to this form—requires a compulsion: one must be faced with the choice of perishing or prevailing. A dominating race can grow up only out of terrible and violent beginnings. Problem: where are the barbarians of the twentieth century? Obviously, they will come into view and consolidate themselves only after tremendous socialist crises—they will be the elements capable of the greatest severity toward themselves and able to guarantee the most enduring will. 869 (1885-1886) The most powerful and most dangerous passions of man, of which he can most easily perish, have been outlawed so completely that the most powerful men themselves have become impossible or have had to feel evil—“harmful and forbidden.” This loss is considerable, but hitherto it has been unavoidable: now that a host of counterforces has been reared by the temporary suppression of those passions (of lust for power, pleasure in change and deception), it is again possible to unloose them: they will no longer possess their old savagery. We permit ourselves a tame barbarism: just look at our artists and statesmen. 870 (1884) The root of all evil: that the slavish morality of meekness, chastity, selflessness, absolute obedience, has triumphed—ruling natures were thus condemned (1) to hypocrisy, (1) to torments of conscience—creative natures felt like rebels against God, uncertain and inhibited by eternal values. The barbarians showed that the ability for restraint was not at home among them: they feared and slandered the passions and drives of nature—also the view of the ruling Caesars and classes. On the other hand, the suspicion arose that all moderation was weakness, or a sign of growing old and weary (—thus La Rochefoucauld suspected that “virtue” was a pretty word among those who could no longer take any pleasure in vice). Moderation itself was represented as a matter of severity, self-conquest, asceticism, as a fight with the devil, etc. The natural delight of aesthetic natures in measure, the enjoyment of the beauty of measure, was overlooked or denied, because one desired an anti-eudaemonistic morality. The faith in the pleasure of moderation—that pleasure of the rider on a fiery steed!—has been lacking hitherto.—The mediocrity of weaker natures has been confused with the moderation of the strong! In summa: the best things have

been slandered because the weak or the immoderate swine have cast a bad light on them— and the best men have remained hidden—and have often misunderstood themselves.

871 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The vicious and unbridled: their depressive influence on the value of the desires. It was the dreadful barbarism of custom that, especially in the Middle Ages, compelled the creation of a veritable “league of virtue”—together with an equally dreadful exaggeration of that which constitutes the value of man. Struggling “civilization” (taming) needs every kind of irons and torture to maintain itself against terribleness and beast-of-prey natures. Here a confusion is quite natural, although its influence has been fatal: that which men of power and will are able to demand of themselves also provides a measure of that which they may permit themselves. Such natures are the antithesis of the vicious and unbridled: although they may on occasion do things that would convict a lesser man of vice and immoderation. Here the concept of the “equal value of men before God” is extraordinarily harmful; one forbade actions and attitudes that were in themselves among the prerogatives of the strongly constituted—as if they were in themselves unworthy of men. One brought the entire tendency of the strong into disrepute when one erected the protective measures of the weakest (those who were weakest also when confronting themselves) as a norm of value. Confusion went so far that one branded the very virtuosi of life (whose autonomy offered the sharpest antithesis to the vicious and unbridled) with the most opprobrious names. Even now one believes one must disapprove of a Cesare Borgia; that is simply laughable. The church has excommunicated German emperors on account of their vices: as if a monk or priest had any right to join in a discussion about what a Frederick II may demand of himself. A Don Juan is sent to hell: that is very naive. Has it been noticed that in heaven all interesting men are missing?— Just a hint to the girls as to where they can best find their salvation.— If one reflects with some consistency, and moreover with a deepened insight into what a “great man” is, no doubt remains that the church sends all “great men” to hell—it fights against all “greatness of man.” 872 (1884)

The rights a man arrogates to himself are related to the duties he imposes upon himself, to the tasks to which he feels equal. The great majority of men have no right to existence, but are a misfortune to higher men.⁴ 873 (1884)

Misunderstanding of egoism—on the part of common natures who know nothing whatever of the pleasure of conquest and the insatiability of great love, nor of the overflowing feeling of strength that desires to overpower, to compel to itself, to lay to its heart—the drive of the artist in relation to his material. Often it is merely the penchant for activity that is looking for a field of action. In ordinary “egoism” it is precisely the “non-ego,” the profoundly average creature, the species man, who desires to preserve himself: if this is perceived by rarer, subtler, and less average men, it enrages them. For they judge: “we are nobler! Our preservation is more important than that of those cattle!” 874 (1884) The

degeneration of the rulers and the ruling classes has been the cause of the greastest mischief in history! Without the Roman Caesars and Roman society, the insanity of Christianity would never have come to power. When lesser men begin to doubt whether higher men exist, then the danger is great! And one ends by discovering that there is virtue also among the lowly and subjugated, the poor in spirit, and that before God men are equal—which has so far been the non plus ultra of nonsense on earth! For ultimately, the higher men measured themselves according to the standard of virtue of slaves—found they were “proud,” etc., found all their higher qualities reprehensible. When Nero and Caracalla sat up there, the paradox arose: “the lowest man is worth more than that man up there!” And the way was prepared for an image of God that was as remote as possible from the image of the most powerful—the god on the cross! 875 (1884) The higher man and the herd man. When great men are lacking, one makes demigods or whole gods out of the great men of the past: the outbreak of religion demonstrates that man no longer delights man (—“no, nor woman neither,” with Hamlet). Or: one brings many men together into one heap as a parliament and hopes they will be equally tyrannical. “Tyrannization” is the quality of great men: they make lesser men stupid. 876 (1888) The best example of the degree to which a plebeian agitator of the mob is incapable of comprehending the concept “higher nature” is provided by Buckle. The view he combats so passionately—that “great men,” individuals, princes, statesmen, geniuses, generals are the levers and causes of all great movements—is instinctively misunderstood by him, as if it meant that what is essential and valuable in such “higher men” were their capacity for setting masses in motion: in short, their effect. But the “higher nature” of the great man lies in being different, in incommunicability, in distance of rank, not in an effect of any kind—even if he made the whole globe tremble.⁵

877 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

The Revolution made Napoleon possible: that is its justification. For the sake of a similar prize one would have to desire the anarchical collapse of our entire civilization. Napoleon made nationalism possible: that is its excuse.⁶ The value of a man (apart from his morality or immorality, naturally; for with these concepts the value of a man is not even touched) does not reside in his utility; for it would continue to exist even if there were no one to whom he could be of any use. And why could not precisely that man who produced the most disastrous effects be the pinnacle of the whole species of man: so high, so superior that everything would perish from envy of him?

878 (Spring-Fall 1887)

To appraise the value of a man according to how useful he is to men, or how much he costs, or what harm he does them—that is as much—or as little—as to appraise a work of art according to the effects it produces. But in this way, the value of a man in comparison with other men is not even touched upon. “Moral evaluation,” in so far as it is a social evaluation, measures men exclusively according to the effects they produce. A man with a taste of his own, enclosed and concealed by his solitude, incommunicable, reserved—an unfathomed man, thus a man of a higher, at any rate a different species: how should you be able to evaluate him, since you cannot know him, cannot compare him? Moral valuation has resulted in the greatest obtuseness of judgment: the value of a man in himself is underrated, almost overlooked, almost denied. Remnant of naive teleology: the value of man only in relation to men.

879 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Preoccupation with morality places a spirit in a low order of rank: he lacks the instinct for privilege, the *a parte*, the feeling of freedom of creative natures, of the “children of God” (or of the devil—). And it is all one whether he preaches current morality or uses his ideal for a critique of current morality: he belongs to the herd—even if it be as the herd’s supreme requirement, its “shepherd.”

880 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Replacement of morality by the will to our goal, and consequently to the means to it.

881 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

Order of rank:— What is mediocre in the typical man? That he does not understand the necessity for the reverse side of things: that he combats evils as if one could dispense with them; that he will not take the one with the other—that he wants to erase and extinguish the typical character of a thing, a condition, an age, a person, approving of only one part of their qualities and wishing to abolish the others. The “desirability” of the mediocre is what we others combat: the ideal conceived as something in which nothing harmful, evil, dangerous, questionable, destructive would remain. Our insight is the opposite of this: that with every growth of man, his other side must grow too; that the highest man, if such a concept be allowed, would be the man who represented the antithetical character of existence most strongly, as its glory and sole justification— Commonplace men can represent only a tiny nook and corner of this natural character: they perish when the multiplicity of elements and the tension of opposites, i.e., the preconditions for greatness in man, increases. That man must grow better and more evil is my formula for this inevitability— Most men represent pieces and fragments of man: one has to add them up for a complete man to appear. Whole ages, whole peoples are in this sense somewhat fragmentary; it is perhaps part of the economy of human evolution that man should evolve piece by piece. But that should not make one forget for a moment that the real issue is the production of the synthetic man; that lower men, the tremendous majority, are merely preludes and rehearsals out of whose medley the whole man appears here and there, the milestone man who indicates how far humanity has advanced so far. It does not advance in a single straight line; often a type once achieved is lost again (—with all the tensions of the past three hundred years, for example, we have not yet reattained the man of the Renaissance, and the man of the Renaissance, in turn, is inferior to the man of antiquity).⁷

882 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

One recognizes the superiority of the Greek man and the Renaissance man—but one would like to have them without the causes and conditions that made them possible.

883 (Spring-Fall 1887)

“Purification of taste” can only be the result of a strengthening of the type. Our society of today only represents culture; the cultured man is lacking. The great synthetic man is lacking, in whom the various forces are unhesitatingly harnessed for the attainment of one goal. What we possess is the multifarious man, perhaps the most interesting chaos there has ever been, but not the chaos before the creation of a world, but that after—Goethe as the most beautiful expression of the type (—absolutely not an Olympian!).^{7a}

884 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Handel, Leibniz, Goethe, Bismarck—characteristic of the strong German type. Existing blithely among antitheses, full of that supple strength that guards against convictions and doctrines by employing one against the other and reserving freedom for itself.

885 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

I have grasped this much: if one had made the rise of great and rare men dependent upon the approval of the many (assuming that the latter knew what qualities belonged to greatness and also at whose expense all greatness evolves) —well, there would never have been a single significant man!— That the course of things makes its way independently of the approval of the great majority: that is why a few astonishing things have insinuated themselves on the earth.

886 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The order of rank of human values.— a. One should not evaluate a man according to individual works. Epidermal actions. Nothing is rarer than a personal action. A class, a rank, a race, an environment, an accident—anything is more likely to be expressed in a work or act than is a “personality” [eine “Person”]. b. One should not assume in any case that many men are “personalities.” And then some are several personalities, most are none.

Wherever the average qualities preponderate, on which the preservation of a type depends, being a personality would be a waste, a luxury, it would be senseless to demand a “personality.” They are bearers, tools of transmission. c. The “personality,” a relatively isolated fact; considering the far greater importance of continuation and averageness, almost something antinatural. For the production of a personality one needs early isolation, a compulsion to an existence of defense and combat, something like an incarceration, a greater power of self-definition; and above all a much lower impressionability than that of the average man, whose humanity is contagious. First question concerning order of rank: how solitary or how gregarious one is. (In the latter case, one’s value resides in the qualities that secure the survival of one’s herd, one’s type; in the former, in that which distinguishes, isolates, defends one, and makes one’s solitariness possible.) Consequence: one should not evaluate the solitary type from the viewpoint of the gregarious, nor the gregarious from the viewpoint of the solitary. Viewed from a height, both are necessary; their antagonism is also necessary—and nothing should be banished more thoroughly than the “desirability” that some third thing might evolve out of the two (“virtue” as hermaphroditism). That is as little “desirable” as the approximation and reconciliation of the sexes. To evolve further that which is typical, to make the gulf wider and wider—— Concept of degeneration in both cases: when the herd starts to acquire the qualities of the solitary, and the latter the qualities of the herd—in short, when they approximate each other. This concept of degeneration has nothing to do with moral evaluation.

887 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Where one must seek the stronger natures.— The ruin and degeneration of the solitary species is much greater and more terrible; they have the instincts of the herd, the tradition of values, against them; their instruments of defense, their protective instincts, are from the beginning not sufficiently strong or certain—chance must be very favorable to them if they are to prosper (—they prosper most often in the lowest and socially most abandoned elements; if one looks for personality, that is where one finds it much more certainly than in the middle classes!). The strata and class struggle that aims at “equality of rights”—once it is more or less over, the war against the solitary personality will begin. (In a certain sense, the latter can maintain and develop himself most easily in a democratic society: namely, when the coarser means of defense are no longer necessary and habits of order, honesty, justice, and trust are part of the usual conditions.) The strongest must be bound most firmly, watched, laid in chains, and guarded—if the instinct of the herd has its way. For them a regime of self-control, ascetic detachment, or “duty” in exhausting work in which one completely loses oneself.

888 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

I attempt an economic justification of virtue.— The task is to make man as useful as possible and to approximate him, as far as possible, to an infallible machine: to this end he must be equipped with the virtues of the machine (—he must learn to experience the states in which he works in a mechanically useful way as the supremely valuable states; hence it is necessary to spoil the other states for him as much as possible, as highly dangerous and disreputable). The first stumbling block is the boredom, the monotony, that all mechanical activity brings with it. To learn to endure this— and not only endure it—to learn to see boredom enveloped in a higher charm: this has hitherto been the task of all higher schooling. To learn something that is of no concern to us, and to find one’s “duty” precisely in this “objective” activity; to learn to value pleasure and duty as altogether separate things—that is the invaluable task and achievement of higher schooling. This is why the philologist has hitherto been the educator as such: because his activity provides the model of sublime monotony in action; under his banner the young man learns to “grind”: first prerequisite for future efficiency in the fulfillment of mechanical duties (as civil servant, husband, office slave, newspaper reader, and soldier). Such an existence perhaps requires a philosophical justification and transfiguration more than any other: agreeable feelings in general must be relegated to a lower rank by some sort of infallible court of appeal; “duty in itself,” perhaps even the pathos of reverence in regard to everything disagreeable—and this demand speaking imperatively from beyond any question of utility, amusement, purpose— The mechanical form of existence as the highest, most venerable form of existence, worshiping itself (—type: Kant as a fanatic of the formal concept “thou shalt”).⁸

889 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

The economic valuation of ideals hitherto—i.e., selection of certain affects and states, selected and reared at the expense of others. The lawgiver (or the instinct of society) selects a number of states and affects through whose operation a regularity in performance is guaranteed (namely, a mechanical performance as a consequence of the regular requirements of those affects and states). Supposing that these states and affects contain painful ingredients, then a means must be found to overcome these painful ingredients through a value-idea designed to make displeasure seem valuable and therefore pleasurable in a higher sense. Reduced to a formula: “How can something disagreeable become agreeable?” For example, when our obedience, our submission to the law, attain honor through the strength, power, self-overcoming they entail.⁹ As do our consideration for the community, the neighbor, the fatherland, our “humanization,” our “altruism,” “heroism.” That one should like to do disagreeable things—that is the object of ideals.

890 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The dwarfing of man must for a long time count as the only goal; because a broad foundation has first to be created so that a stronger species of man can stand upon it. (To what extent every strengthened species of man hitherto has stood upon a level of the lower——)

891 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Absurd and contemptible form of idealism that would not have mediocrity mediocre and, instead of feeling a sense of triumph at a state of exceptionalness, becomes indignant over cowardice, falsity, pettiness, and wretchedness. One should not desire these things to be different! and should make the gulf wider!— One should compel the higher kind of man to sever himself from the others through the sacrifices he has to make to his state of being. Chief viewpoint: establish distances, but create no antitheses. Dissolve the intermediate forms and reduce their influence: chief means of preserving distances.

892 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

How should one wish to spoil mediocrity for the mediocre! As one will see, I do the opposite: every step away from it—so I teach—leads to immorality.¹⁰

893 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Hatred for mediocrity is unworthy of a philosopher: it is almost a question mark against his “right to philosophy.” Precisely because he is an exception he has to take the rule under his protection, he has to keep the mediocre in good heart.

894 (Spring-Fall 1887)

What I fight against: that an exceptional type should make war on the rule—instead of grasping that the continued existence of the rule is the precondition for the value of the exception. For example, the ladies who, instead of feeling their abnormal thirst for scholarship as a distinction, want to disrupt the status of woman in general.

895 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The increase of force despite the temporary decline of the individual: to establish a new level: a method of assembling forces for the preservation of small achievements, in opposition to uneconomic waste; destructive nature temporarily subdued as an instrument for this future economy; preservation of the weak, because a tremendous number of petty tasks have to be performed; preservation of an attitude of mind that makes existence still possible for the weak and suffering; to implant solidarity as an instinct against the instinct of fear and servility; struggle against accident, also against the accident of “great men.”

896 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Struggle against men justified on economic grounds. They are dangerous, accidents, exceptions, tempests, strong enough to call in question things slowly built and established. Explosives should not merely be detonated harmlessly; where possible detonation should be prevented: fundamental instinct of all civilized society.

897 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

Whoever reflects upon the way in which the type man can be raised to his greatest spendor and power will grasp first of all that he must place himself outside morality; for morality has been essentially directed to the opposite end: to obstruct or destroy that spendid evolution wherever it has been going on. For such an evolution does indeed consume so great a quantity of men in its service that a reverse movement is only too natural: the weaker, more delicate, intermediate existences need to take sides against that gloriousness of life and strength; and to that end they have to acquire a new valuation of themselves by virtue of which they can condemn life in this highest plenitude, and where possible destroy it. A tendency hostile to life is therefore characteristic of morality, in so far as it wants to overpower the types of life.

898 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The strong of the future.— That which partly necessity, partly chance has achieved here and there, the conditions for the production of a stronger type, we are now able to comprehend and consciously will: we are able to create the conditions under which such an elevation is possible. Until now, “education” has had in view the needs of society: not the possible needs of the future, but the needs of the society of the day. One desired to produce “tools” for it. Assuming the wealth of force were greater, one could imagine forces being subtracted, not to serve the needs of society but some future need. Such a task would have to be posed the more it was grasped to what extent the contemporary form of society was being so powerfully transformed that at some future time it would be unable to exist for its own sake alone, but only as a tool in the hands of a stronger race. The increasing dwarfing of man is precisely the driving force that brings to mind the breeding of a stronger race—a race that would be excessive precisely where the dwarfed species was weak and growing weaker (in will, responsibility, self-assurance, ability to posit goals for oneself). The means would be those history teaches: isolation through interests in preservation that are the reverse of those which are average today; habituation to reverse evaluations; distance as a pathos; a free conscience in those things that today are most undervalued and prohibited. The homogenizing of European man is the great process that cannot be obstructed: one should even hasten it. The necessity to create a gulf, distance, order of rank, is given *eo ipso*—not the necessity to retard this process. As soon as it is established, this homogenizing species requires a justification: it lies in serving a higher sovereign species that stands upon the former and can raise itself to its task only by doing this. Not merely a master race whose sole task is to rule, but a race with its own sphere of life, with an excess of strength for beauty, bravery, culture, manners to the highest peak of the spirit; an affirming race that may grant itself every great luxury— strong enough to have no need of the tyranny of the virtue-imperative, rich enough to have no need of thrift and pedantry, beyond good and evil; a hothouse for strange and choice plants. 899 (1885) Our psychologists, whose glance lingers involuntarily on symptoms of decadence alone, again and again induce us to mistrust the spirit. One always sees only those effects of the spirit that make men weak, delicate, and morbid; but now there are coming 900 (1885) I point to something new: certainly for such a democratic type there exists the danger of the barbarian, but one has looked for it only in the depths. There exists also another type of barbarian, who comes from the heights: a species of conquering and ruling natures in search of material to mold. Prometheus was this kind of barbarian. 901 (Spring-Fall 1887)¹² Main consideration: not to see the task of the higher species in leading the lower (as, e.g., Comte does), but the lower as a base upon which higher

species performs its own tasks—upon which alone it can stand. The conditions under which a strong and noble species maintains itself (regarding spiritual discipline) are the reverse of those which govern the “industrial masses,” the shopkeepers à la Spencer. That which is available only to the strongest and most fruitful natures and makes their existence possible—leisure, adventure, disbelief, even dissipation—would, if it were available to mediocre natures, necessarily destroy them—and actually does. This is where industriousness, rule, moderation, firm “conviction” have their place—in short, the “herd virtues”: under them this intermediate type of man grows perfect.

902 (Manuscript source uncertain)

On the sovereign types.— The “shepherd” as opposed to the “master” (—the former a means of preserving the herd; the latter the end for which the herd exists).

903 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Temporary preponderance of the social value-feelings comprehensible and useful: it is a question of creating a foundation upon which a stronger species will ultimately be possible.— Standard of strength: to be able to live under the reverse evaluations and to will them again eternally. State and society as foundation: world-economic point of view, education as breeding.¹³

904 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Insight that “free spirits” lack: the identical discipline that makes a strong nature even stronger and capable of great undertakings, shatters and withers the mediocre:—doubt—*la largeur de coeur*—experiment—independence. 905 (1885-1886) The hammer. How would men have to be constituted whose evaluations would be the reverse?— Men who possess all the qualities of the modern soul, but are strong enough to transform them into pure health?— The means they employ in their task. 906 (1883-1888) The strong man, mighty in the instincts of a powerful health, digests his deeds in just the same way as he digests his meals; he can cope even with heavy food: in the main, however, he is led by a faultless and severe instinct into doing nothing that disagrees with him, just as he eats nothing he does not enjoy. 907 (1884) If only we could foresee the most favorable conditions under which creatures of the highest value arise! It is a thousand times too complicated and the probability of failure very great: so it is not inspiring to look for them!— Skepticism.— On the other hand: we can increase courage, insight, hardness, independence, and the feeling of responsibility; we can make the scales more delicate and hope for the assistance of favorable accidents. 908 (1884) Before we can think of acting, a tremendous amount of work has to be done. In the main, however, a shrewd exploitation of the given situation is, no doubt, our best, most advisable course of action. The actual creation of such conditions as are created by chance presupposes iron men who have never yet lived. The immediate task is to make the personal ideal prevail and become real! He who has grasped the nature of man, the origin of man’s highest, shudders at man and flees from all action: consequence of inherited valuations! ! That the nature of man is evil, is my consolation: it guarantees strength!

909 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The typical forms of self-formation. Or: the eight principal questions. Whether one wants to be more multifarious or simpler? Whether one wants to become happier or more indifferent to happiness and unhappiness? Whether one wants to become more contented with oneself or more exacting and inexorable? Whether one wants to become softer, more yielding, more human, or more “inhuman”? Whether one wants to become more prudent or more ruthless? Whether one wants to reach a goal or to avoid all goals (as, e.g., the philosopher does who smells a boundary, a nook, a prison, a stupidity in every goal)? Whether one wants to become more respected or more feared? Or more despised? Whether one wants to become tyrant or seducer or shepherd or herd animal?

910 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Type of my disciples.— To those human beings who are of any concern to me I wish suffering, desolation, sickness, ill-treatment, indignities—I wish that they should not remain unfamiliar with profound self-contempt, the torture of self-mistrust, the wretchedness of the vanquished: I have no pity for them, because I wish them the only thing that can prove today whether one is worth anything or not—that one endures.¹⁵ 911 (1885-1886) The happiness and self-contentment of the Lazzaroni or the “bliss” of “beautiful souls” or the consumptive love of Herrnhuteristic pietists prove nothing regarding order of rank among men. As a great educator, one would have to scourge such a race of “blessed people” mercilessly into unhappiness. The danger of dwarfing, of relaxation is present at once:—against Spinozistic or Epicurean happiness and against all relaxation in contemplative states. But if virtue is the means to such a happiness, very well, then one has to become master over virtue, too.

912 (March-June 1888)

I absolutely cannot see how one can later make up for having failed to go to a good school at the proper time. Such a man does not know himself; he walks through life without having learned to walk; his flabby muscles reveal themselves with every step. Sometimes life is so merciful as to offer this hard schooling once more later: sickness for years perhaps, that demands the most extreme strength of will and self-sufficiency; or a sudden calamity, affecting also one's wife and child, that compels one to a form of activity that restores energy to the slack fibers and toughness to the will to live. The most desirable thing is still under all circumstances a hard discipline at the proper time, ie, at that age at which it still makes one proud to see that much is demanded of one. For this is what distinguishes the hard school as a good school from all others: that much is demanded; and sternly demanded; that the good, even the exceptional, is demanded as the norm; that praise is rare, that indulgence is nonexistent; that blame is apportioned sharply, objectively, without regard for talent or antecedents. One needs such a school from every point of view: that applies to the most physical as well as to the most spiritual matters; it would be fatal to desire to draw a distinction here! The same discipline makes both the good soldier and the good scholar; and looked at more closely, there is no good scholar who does not have the instincts of a good soldier in his makeup. To be able to command and also proudly to obey; to stand in the ranks, but also capable at any time of leading; to prefer danger to comfort; not to weigh the permitted and the forbidden on a shopkeeper's scales; to be a foe more of the petty, sly, parasitic, than of the evil.— What does one learn in a hard school? Obeying and commanding. 913 (1885-1886) To disavow merit: but to do that which is above all praise, indeed above all understanding. 914 (1885-1886) New form of morality: common vows over what one intends to do and leave undone, emphatic renunciation of many things. Tests to see if one is ripe for it.¹⁸

915 (Spring-Fall 1887)

I also want to make asceticism natural again: in place of the aim of denial, the aim of strengthening; a gymnastics of the will; abstinence and periods of fasting of all kinds, in the most spiritual realm, too; a casuistry of deeds in regard to the opinions we have regarding our strengths; an experiment with adventures and arbitrary dangers. (*Dîners chez Magny*: nothing but spiritual gourmets with indigestion.¹⁹)— One should even devise tests for one's strength in being able to keep one's word. 916 (1884; rev. Spring-Fall 1888) What has been ruined by the church's misuse of it: asceticism: one has hardly the courage so far to display its natural utility, its indispensability in the service of the education of the will. Our absurd pedagogic world, before which the "useful civil servant" hovers as a model, thinks it can get by with "instruction," with brain drill; it has not the slightest idea that something else is needed first—education of will power; one devises tests for everything except for the main thing: whether one can will, whether one may promise; the young man finishes school without a single question, without any curiosity even, concerning this supreme value-problem of his nature; fasting: in every sense—even as a means of preserving the delicacy of one's ability to enjoy all good things (e.g., occasionally to stop reading, listening to music, being pleasant; one must have fast days for one's virtues, too); the "monastery": temporary isolation, accompanied by strict refusal, e.g., of letters; a kind of most profound self-reflection and self-recovery that desires to avoid, not "temptations," but "duties": an escape from the daily round; a detachment from the tyranny of stimuli and influences that condemns us to spend our strength in nothing but reactions and does not permit their accumulation to the point of spontaneous activity (one should observe our scholars from close up: they think only reactively; i.e., they have to read before they can think); feasts: One has to be very coarse in order not to feel the presence of Christians and Christian values as an oppression beneath which all genuine festive feelings go to the devil. Feasts include: pride, exuberance, wantonness; mockery of everything serious and Philistine; a divine affirmation of oneself out of animal plenitude and perfection—one and all states which the Christian cannot honestly welcome. The feast is paganism par excellence; courage confronted with one's own nature: dressing up in "moral" costumes.— That one has no need of moral formulas in order to welcome an affect; standard: how far we can affirm what is nature in us—how much or how little we need to have recourse to morality; death.— One must convert the stupid physiological fact into a moral necessity. So to live that one can also will at the right time to die!^{19a}

917 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

To feel stronger—or in other words, joy—always presupposes a comparison (but not necessarily with others, but with oneself in the midst of a state of growth and without one's first knowing in how far one is making comparisons—). Artificial strengthening: whether by stimulating chemicals or by stimulating errors (“delusions”): e.g., the feeling of security such as a Christian possesses; he feels strong in being able to trust, to be patient and composed: he owes this artificial strength to the illusion of being protected by a god; e.g., the feeling of superiority: as when the caliph of Morocco is allowed to see only globes upon which his three united kingdoms occupy four-fifths of the surface; e.g., the feeling of uniqueness: as when the European imagines that the march of culture takes place in Europe, and when he seems to himself to be a kind of abridged world process; or when the Christian makes all existence in general revolve around the “salvation of man.” —It is a question of where one feels the pressure, the constraint: according to where this is, a different feeling of being stronger will be produced. A philosopher, e.g., feels in the midst of the coolest, most transmontane abstraction acrobatics like a fish in water, while colors and tones oppress him; to say nothing of the dim desires—that which others call “the ideal.”

918 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

One would make a fit little boy stare if one asked him: “Would you like to become virtuous?”— but he will open his eyes wide if asked: “Would you like to become stronger than your friends?”— * How does one become stronger?— By coming to decisions slowly; and by clinging tenaciously to what one has decided. Everything else follows. The sudden and the changeable: the two species of weakness. Not to mistake oneself for one of them; to feel the distance— before it is too late! Beware of the good-natured! Association with them makes one languid. All associations are good that make one practice the weapons of defense and offense that reside in one’s instincts. All one’s inventiveness toward testing one’s strength of will— To see the distinguishing feature in this, and not in knowledge, astuteness, wit. One must learn in time to command—just as much as to obey. One must learn modesty, tact in modesty: that is, to confer distinction and to honor by being modest; the same with trust—. to confer distinction, to honor. * For what does one have to atone most? For one’s modesty; for having failed to listen to one’s most personal requirements; for having mistaken oneself; for having underestimated oneself; for having lost a good ear for one’s instincts this lack of reverence for oneself revenges itself through every kind of deprivation: health, friendship, well-being, pride, cheerfulness, freedom, firmness, courage. One never afterward forgives oneself for this lack of genuine egoism: one takes it for an objection, for a doubt about a real ego.

919 (March-June 1888)

I wish men would begin by respecting themselves: everything else follows from that. To be sure, as soon as one does this one is finished for others: for this is what they forgive last: “What? A man who respects himself?”— This is something different from the blind drive to love oneself: nothing is more common, in the love of the sexes as well as of that duality which is called “I,” than contempt for what one loves:—fatalism in love.

920 (Spring-Fall 1887)

“I want this or that”; “I wish that this or that were thus”; “I know that this or that is thus”—the degrees of strength: the man of will, the man of desire, the man of faith.

921 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The means by which a stronger species maintains itself. To grant oneself the right to exceptional actions; as an experiment in self-overcoming and freedom. To venture into states in which it is not permitted not to be a barbarian. To create control and certainty in regard to one's strength of will through asceticism of every kind. Not to communicate oneself; silence; beware of charm.²⁰ To learn obedience in such a way that it provides a test of one's self-support. Casuistry of honor taken to the greatest extreme of subtlety. Never to conclude "what is right for one is fair for another"—but conversely! To treat requital, the permission to give back, as a privilege and a rare distinction. To have no ambition to emulate the virtues of others.

922 (Spring-Fall 1887)

What means one has to employ with rude peoples, and that “barbarous” means are not arbitrary and capricious, becomes palpable in practice as soon as one is placed, with all one’s European pampering, in the necessity of keeping control over barbarians, in the Congo or elsewhere.

923 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

The warlike and the peaceful.— Are you a man with the instincts of a warrior in your system? If so, a second question arises: are you by instinct a warrior of attack or a warrior of defense? The remainder of mankind, all that is not warlike by instinct, wants peace, wants concord, wants “freedom,” wants “equal rights”: these are only different names and stages of the same thing. To go where one has no need to defend oneself—such men become dissatisfied with themselves if they are obliged to offer resistance: [they want to]²¹ create conditions in which there is no longer war of any kind. If the worst comes to the worst, to submit, obey, acquiesce: anything is better than waging war—thus, e.g., does a Christian’s instinct counsel him. In the case of the born warrior, there is something like armament in his character, in his choice of states, in the development of every quality: in the first type, it is the “weapon” that is developed best, in the latter the armor. The unarmed, the unarmored: what expedients and virtues they need in order to endure—to triumph.

924 (Spring-Fall 1887)

What will become of the man who no longer has any reasons for defending himself or for attacking? What affects does he have left if he has lost those in which lie his weapons of defense and attack?

925 (Summer-Fall 1888)

Marginal note on a *niaiserie anglaise*.²²— “Do not unto others what you would not have them do unto you.” That counts as wisdom; that counts as prudence; that counts as the basis of morality—as the “golden rule.” John Stuart Mill believes in it (and what Englishman does not?) But this rule does not brook the slightest attack. The calculation, “do nothing that ought not to be done to you,” prohibits actions on account of their harmful consequences: the concealed premise is that an action will always be requited. But what if someone holding the *Principe* in his hand were to say: “It is precisely such actions that one must perform, to prevent others from performing them first—to deprive others of the chance to perform them on us”? On the other hand: let us consider a Corsican whose honor demands a vendetta. He does not want a bullet in his body either; but this prospect, the probability of getting shot, does not deter him from vindicating his honor— And in all decent actions, are we not deliberately indifferent to the prospect of what may happen to us? To avoid an action that might have harmful consequences for us—that would mean a ban on decent actions in general. Nonetheless, the rule is valuable because it betrays a type of man: it is the instinct of the herd that finds its formula in this rule—one is equal, one takes oneself for equal: as I to you, thus you to me.— Here there is a real belief in an equivalence of actions that in all actual circumstances simply does not exist. Not every action can be returned: between actual “individuals” there are no equal actions, consequently no “requital”— When I do something, I am very far from thinking that anyone else can do much the same: it belongs to me — One cannot pay me back, it will always be “another” action that is perpetrated against me.—

926 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Against John Stuart Mill.— I abhor his vulgarity, which says: “What is right for one is fair for another”; “what you would not, etc., do not unto others”; which wants to establish all human intercourse on the basis of mutual services, so that every action appears as a kind of payment for something done to us. The presupposition here is ignoble in the lowest sense: here an equivalence of value between my actions and yours is presupposed; here the most personal value of an action is simply annulled (that which cannot be balanced or paid in any way—). “Reciprocity” is a piece of gross vulgarity; precisely that something I do may not and could not be done by another, that no balance is possible (—except in the most select sphere of “my equals,” *inter pares*—), that in a deeper sense one never gives back, because one is something unique and does only unique things —this fundamental conviction contains the cause of aristocratic segregation from the masses, because the masses believe in “equality” and consequently in equivalence and “reciprocity.”

927 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The parochial narrowness of moral valuation with its “useful” and “harmful” has its own good reasons; it is the necessary perspective of society, which is able to survey only the close and closest in regard to consequences. The state and the politician already have need of a more supra-moral attitude, because they have to reckon with a much greater complexity of effects. A world economy would also be possible with such distant perspectives that all its individual demands might seem unjust and arbitrary at the moment.

928 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

“Should one follow one’s feelings?”—That one should put one’s life in danger, yielding to a generous feeling and under the impulse of a moment, that is of little value and does not even characterize one. Everyone is equally capable of that—and in this resolution, a criminal, a bandit, and a Corsican certainly excel decent people. A higher stage is: to overcome even this pressure within us and to perform a heroic act not on impulse—but coldly, *raisonnable*, without being overwhelmed by stormy feelings of pleasure— The same applies to compassion: it must first be habitually sifted by reason; otherwise it is just as dangerous as any other affect. Blind indulgence of an affect, totally regardless of whether it be a generous and compassionate or a hostile affect, is the cause of the greatest evils. Greatness of character does not consist in not possessing these affects—on the contrary, one possesses them to the highest degree—but in having them under control. And even that without any pleasure in this restraint, but merely because

929 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

“To give one’s life for a cause”—a great effect. But there are many things for which one would give one’s life: the affects one and all desire to be gratified. Whether it be compassion or anger or revenge—that one stakes one’s life on it does not make any value difference. How many have sacrificed their lives for pretty girls—and, worse, even their health! If one has the temperament, one instinctively chooses what is dangerous; e g, adventures in speculation if one is a philosopher; or in immorality if one is virtuous. One kind of man will risk nothing, another wants risks. Are we others despisers of life? On the contrary, we seek life raised to a higher power, life lived in danger—²⁴ But that, to repeat it, does not mean we want to be more virtuous than others. Pascal, e.g., wanted to risk nothing and remained a Christian: perhaps that was virtuous.— One always makes sacrifices.

930 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

How much advantage man sacrifices, how little “self-interested” he is! All his affects and passions demand their rights— and how remote from the prudent utility of self-interest is an affect! One does not desire “happiness”; one must be English to be able to believe that man always seeks his advantage.²⁶ Our desires want to violate things with a protracted passion—their accumulated strength seeks resistance.

931 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The affects are one and all useful, some directly, others indirectly; in regard to utility it is quite impossible to fix any scale of values—even though in economic terms the forces of nature are one and all good, i.e., useful, and also the source of so much terrible and irrevocable fatality. The most one could say is that the most powerful affects are the most valuable, in as much as there are no greater sources of strength.

932 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Well-meaning, helpful, good-natured attitudes of mind have not come to be honored on account of their usefulness, but because they are states of richer souls that are capable of bestowing and have their value in the feeling of the plenitude of life. Observe the eyes of benefactors: what one sees is the antithesis of self-denial, of hatred for the moi, of “Pascalism.”

933 (Spring-Fall 1887)

In Summa: domination of the passions, not their weakening or extirpation!—The greater the dominating power of a will, the more freedom may the passions be allowed. The “great man” is great owing to the free play and scope of his desires and to the yet greater power that knows how to press these magnificent monsters into service. The “good man” is at every stage of civilization the harmless and the useful combined: a kind of mean; the expression of the general consciousness of the kind of man whom one has no reason to fear but whom one must nonetheless not despise. Education: essentially the means of ruining the exceptions for the good of the rule.²⁷ Higher education:²⁸ essentially the means of directing taste against the exceptions for the good of the mediocre. Only when a culture has an excess of powers at its disposal can it also constitute a hothouse for the luxury cultivation of the exception, the experiment, of danger, of the nuance:—this is the tendency of every aristocratic culture.

934 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Nothing but questions of strength: how far to prevail against the conditions that preserve society and against its prejudices?— how far to unchain one's terrible qualities through which most people perish?—how far to oppose truth and reflect on its most questionable sides?—how far to oppose suffering, self-contempt, pity, sickness, vice, with the query as to whether one cannot become master of them? (—what does not destroy us makes us stronger—)—finally: how far to acknowledge in one's mind the rule, the commonplace, the petty, good, upright, the average nature, without letting oneself be vulgarized by them?— Hardest test of character: not to let oneself be ruined through seduction by the good. The good as luxury, as subtlety,³⁰ as vice.

935 (Fall 1888)

Type: True graciousness, nobility, greatness of soul proceed from abundance; do not give in order to receive—do not try to exalt themselves by being gracious;—prodigality as the type of true graciousness, abundance of personality as its presupposition.

936 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Aristocracy. Herd-animal ideals—now culminating as the highest value standard of “society”: attempt to give them a cosmic, even a metaphysical value.— Against them I defend aristocracy. A society that preserves a regard and delicatessen for freedom must feel itself to be an exception and must confront a power from which it distinguishes itself, toward which it is hostile, and on which it looks down. The more I relinquish my rights and level myself down, the more I come under the dominion of the average and finally of the majority. The presupposition inherent in an aristocratic society for preserving a high degree of freedom among its members is the extreme tension that arises from the presence of an antagonistic drive in all its members: the will to dominate— If you would do away with firm opposition and differences in rank, you will also abolish all strong love, lofty attitudes, and the feeling of individuality. * Toward a true psychology of the society based on freedom and equality— What diminishes? The will to self-responsibility, sign of the decline of autonomy; efficiency in defense and attack, also in the most spiritual things: the power of commanding; the sense of reverence, subservience, ability to keep silent; great passion, the great task, tragedy, cheerfulness.

937 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Augustin Thierry read in 1814 what De Montlosier had said in his work *De la monarchie française*: he answered with a cry of indignation and commenced his work. That emigrant had said: Race d'affranchis, race d'esclaves arrachés de nos mains, peuple tributaire, peuple nouveau, licence vous fut octroyée d'être libres, et non pas à nous d'être nobles; pour nous tout est de droit, pour vous tout est de grâce, nous ne sommes point de votre communauté; nous sommes un tout par nous-mêmes.³² 938 (1884) How the aristocratic world increasingly bleeds itself and makes itself weaker! Because of the nobility of its instincts it throws away its privileges and because of the refinement of its hyper-culture it takes an interest in the people, the weak, the poor, the poetry of the petty, etc. 939 (1885-1886) There is a noble and dangerous carelessness that permits a profound inference and insight: the carelessness of the self-assured and overrich soul that has never troubled about friends but knows only hospitality, and practices, and knows how to practice, only hospitality—heart and home open to anyone who cares to enter, whether beggar or cripple or king. This is genuine geniality: whoever has that, has a hundred “friends” but in all probability not a single friend. 940 (1884) The teaching *meden agan* applies to men of overflowing strength—not to the mediocre. The *enkrateia* and *askesis* is only a stage toward the heights: the “golden nature” is higher. “Thou shalt”—unconditional obedience in Stoics, in the Christian and Arab orders, in the philosophy of Kant (it is immaterial whether to a superior or to a concept). Higher than “thou shalt” is “I will” (the heroes); higher than “I will” stands: “I am” (the gods of the Greeks). The barbarian gods express nothing of the pleasure of restraint—are neither simple nor frivolous nor moderate.

941 (Summer-Fall 1883)

The meaning of our gardens and palaces (and to this extent also the meaning of all desire for riches) is: to remove disorder and vulgarity from sight and to build a home for nobility of soul. The majority, to be sure, believe they will acquire higher natures when those beautiful, peaceful objects have operated upon them: hence the rush to go to Italy and on travels, etc.; all reading and visits to theatres. They want to have themselves formed— that is the meaning of their cultural activity! But the strong, the mighty want to form and no longer to have anything foreign about them! Thus men also plunge into wild nature, not to find themselves but to lose and forget themselves in it. “To be outside oneself” as the desire of all the weak and the self-discontented. 942 (1885) There is only nobility of birth, only nobility of blood. (I am not speaking here of the little word “von” or of the Almanach de Gotha:36 parenthesis for asses.) When one speaks of “aristocrats of the spirit,” reasons are usually not lacking for concealing something; as is well known, it is a favorite term among ambitious Jews. For spirit alone does not make noble; rather, there must be something to ennoble the spirit.— What then is required? Blood.³⁷ 943 (1885) What is noble?³⁸ —Care for the most external things, in so far as this care forms a boundary, keeps distant, guards against confusion. —Apparent frivolity in word, dress, bearing, through which a stoic severity and self-constraint protects itself against all immodest inquisitiveness. —Slowness of gesture, and of glance. There are not too many valuable things: and these come and wish to come of themselves to the valuable man. We do not easily admire. —Endurance of poverty and want, also of sickness. —Avoidance of petty honors and mistrust of all who praise readily: for whoever praises believes he understands what he praises: but to understand— Balzac, that typical man of ambition, has revealed it—comprendre c’est égal.³⁹ —Our doubt as to the communicability of the heart goes deep; solitude not as chosen but as given. —The conviction that one has duties only to one’s equals, toward the others one acts as one thinks best: that justice can be hoped for (unfortunately not counted on) only *inter pares*.⁴⁰ —An ironic response to the “talented,” the belief in a nobility by birth in moral matters too. —Always to experience oneself as one who bestows honors, while there are not many fit to honor one. —Always disguised: the higher the type, the more a man requires an incognito. If God existed, he would, merely on grounds of decency, be obliged to show himself to the world only as a man. —The ability for otium,⁴¹ the unconditional conviction that although a craft in any sense does not dishonor, it certainly takes away nobility. No “industriousness” in the bourgeois sense, however well we may know how to honor and reward it, or like those insatiably cackling artists who act like hens, cackle and lay eggs and cackle again. —We protect artists and poets and those who are masters in anything; but as natures

that are of a higher kind than these, who have only the ability to do something, merely “productive men,” we do not confound ourselves with them. —Pleasure in forms; taking under protection everything formal, the conviction that politeness is one of the greatest virtues; mistrust for letting oneself go in any way, including all freedom of press and thought, because under them the spirit grows comfortable and doltish and relaxes its limbs. —Delight in women, as in a perhaps smaller but more delicate and ethereal kind of creature. What joy to encounter creatures who have only dancing, foolishness, and finery in their heads! They have been the delight of every very tense and profound male soul whose life was weighed down with great responsibilities. —Pleasure in princes and priests, because they preserve the belief in differences in human values even in the valuation of the past, at least symbolically and on the whole even actually. —Ability to keep silent: but not a word about that in the presence of listeners. —Endurance of protracted enmities: lack of easy reconcilability. —Disgust for the demagogic, for the “enlightenment,” for “being cozy,”⁴² for plebeian familiarity. —The collection of precious things, the needs of a high and fastidious soul; to desire to possess nothing in common. One’s own books, one’s own landscapes. —We rebel against experiences, good and bad, and are slow to generalize. The individual case: how ironic we feel toward the individual case if it has the bad taste to pose as the rule! —We love the naive and naive people, but as spectators and higher natures; we find Faust just as naive as his Gretchen. —We esteem the good very little, as herd animals: we know that in the worst, most malignant, hardest men a priceless golden drop of goodness is often concealed, that outweighs all mere benevolence of milk souls. —We consider that a man of our kind is not refuted by his vices, nor by his follies. We know that we are hard to recognize, and that we have every reason to give ourselves foregrounds.

944 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

What is noble?— That one constantly has to play a part. That one seeks situations in which one has constant need of poses. That one leaves happiness to the great majority: happiness as peace of soul, virtue, comfort, Anglo-angelic shopkeeperdom à la Spencer. That one instinctively seeks heavy responsibilities. That one knows how to make enemies everywhere, if the worst comes to the worst even of oneself. That one constantly contradicts the great majority not through words but through deeds. 945 (1886-1887) Virtue (e.g., in the form of truthfulness) as our noble and dangerous luxury; we must not refuse the disadvantages it brings with it.

946 (Spring-Fall 1887)

To desire no praise: one does what profits one, or what gives one pleasure, or what one must.

947 (Jan.-Fall 1888)

What is chastity in a man? That his sexual taste has remained noble; that in eroticis he likes neither the brutal nor the morbid nor the prudent.

948 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The “concept of honor”: resting on the faith in “good society,” in chivalrous basic traits, in the obligation continually to maintain poise. Essential: that one does not think one’s life important; that one insists unconditionally on good manners on the part of everyone with whom one comes in contact (at least, when they do not belong to “us”); that one is neither familiar, nor genial, nor merry, nor modest, except *inter pares*; that one always maintains poise.

949 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

That one stakes one's life, one's health, one's honor, is the consequence of high spirits and an overflowing, prodigal will: not from love of man but because every great danger challenges our curiosity about the degree of our strength and our courage. 950 (1884-1886) "Eagles dive straight to the point."— Not the least sign of nobility of soul is the magnificent and proud stupidity with which it attacks—"straight to the point."

951 (Spring-Fall 1887)

War on the effeminate conception of “nobility”!—a quantum more of brutality cannot be dispensed with, any more than closeness to crime. Even “self-satisfaction” is not part of it; one should be adventurous, experimental, destructive also toward oneself—no beautiful-soul twaddle—. I want to make room for a more robust ideal. 952 (1884-1886) “Paradise lies in the shadow of swords”—also a symbol and motto by which souls of noble and warlike origin betray themselves and divine each other. 953 (1886-1887) The two paths.— [There comes]43 a point in time when man has strength in excess at his disposal: science aims at establishing this slavery of nature. Then man acquires leisure: to cultivate himself into something new, higher. New aristocracy. Then a host of virtues are superseded that had been conditions of existence.— Qualities no longer needed are lost. We no longer need virtues: consequently we lose them (—as we do the morality of “one thing is needful,” of salvation of soul, and of immortality: they were means of making possible for man a tremendous self-constraint through the affect of a tremendous fear: : :). The various kinds of indigence through whose discipline man is formed: indigence teaches work, thought, self-constraint. * Physiological purification and strengthening. The new aristocracy has need of an opposite against which it struggles: preservation must be a dreadfully urgent matter. The two futures of mankind: (1) consistent growth of mediocrity; (2) conscious distinction, self-shaping. A doctrine that creates a gulf: it preserves the highest and the lowest kind (it destroys the mean). Aristocrats so far, spiritual and temporal, prove nothing against necessity for a new aristocracy. 954 (1885-1886) A question constantly keeps coming back to us, a seductive and wicked question perhaps: may it be whispered into the ears of those who have a right to such questionable questions, the strongest souls of today, whose best control is over themselves: is it not time, now that the type “herd animal” is being evolved more and more in Europe, to make the experiment of a fundamental, artificial and conscious breeding of the opposite type and its virtues? And would it not be a kind of goal, redemption, and justification for the democratic movement itself if someone arrived who could make use of it—by finally producing beside its new and sublime development of slavery (—that is what European democracy must become ultimately) a higher kind of dominating and Caesarian spirits who would stand upon it, maintain themselves by it, and elevate themselves through it? To new, hitherto impossible prospects, to their own prospects? To their own tasks? 955 (1885) To view the contemporary European makes me very hopeful: an audacious ruling race is developing on the basis of an extremely intelligent herd mass. It will not be long before the movement for the cultivation of the latter will no longer have the foreground all to itself. 956 (1885) The same conditions that hasten the evolution

of the herd animal also hasten the evolution of the leader animal. 957 (1885)

Inexorably, hesitantly, terrible as fate, the great task and question is approaching: how shall the earth as a whole be governed? And to what end shall “man” as a whole—and no longer as a people, a race—be raised and trained? Law-giving moralities are the principal means of fashioning man according to the pleasure of a creative and profound will, provided that such an artist’s will of the first rank has the power in its hands and can make its creative will prevail through long periods of time, in the form of laws, religions, and customs. Such men of great creativity, the really great men according to my understanding, will be sought in vain today and probably for a long time to come: they are lacking; until, after much disappointment, one must begin to comprehend why they are lacking and that nothing stands more malignantly in the way of their rise and evolution, today and for a long time to come, than what in Europe today is called simply “morality”—as if there were no other morality and could be no other—the aforementioned herd-animal morality which is striving with all its power for a universal green-pasture happiness on earth, namely for security, absence of danger, comfort, the easy life, and ultimately, “if all goes well,” hopes to do away with any kind of shepherd or bellwether. The two doctrines it preaches most often are: “equal rights” and “sympathy with all that suffers”—and it takes suffering itself to be something that must absolutely be abolished. That such “ideas” as these are still modern gives one a bad opinion of modernity. Whoever has thought profoundly about where and how the plant man has hitherto grown most vigorously must conclude that this has happened under the reverse conditions: that the dangerousness of his situation must grow to tremendous proportions, that his power of invention and dissembling must struggle up beneath protracted oppression and compulsion, that his will to live must be enhanced to an unconditional will to power and to overpower, and that danger, severity, violence, danger in the street as well as in the heart, inequality of rights, concealment, stoicism, the art of experiment, devilry of all kinds, in short the opposite of all the herd thinks desirable, are necessary for the elevation of the type man. A morality with such reverse intentions, which desires to train men for the heights, not for comfort and mediocrity, a morality with the intention of training a ruling caste—the future masters of the earth—must, if it is to be taught, appear in association with the prevailing moral laws, in the guise of their terms and forms. That for this, however, many transitional means of deception must be devised, and that, because the lifetime of a single man signifies virtually nothing in relation to the accomplishment of such protracted tasks and aims, the very first thing to be done is the rearing of a new kind of man, in whom the duration of the necessary will and the necessary instinct will be guaranteed through many generations—a new master type and caste—all this is as obvious as is the protracted and not easily expressible etcetera of this idea. To prepare a

reversal of values for a certain strong kind of man of the highest spirituality and strength of will and to this end slowly and cautiously to unfetter a host of instincts now kept in check and calumniated—whoever reflects on this becomes one of us, the free spirits—to be sure, a different kind of “free spirit” from those before us; for the latter wanted approximately the opposite of what we do. To us, it seems to me, belong above all the pessimists of Europe, the poets and thinkers of an enraged idealism, in so far as their discontent with all existence involved them at least by logical necessity in a discontent with present-day man; also certain insatiably ambitious artists who unhesitatingly and unconditionally fight for the special rights of higher men and against the “herd animal” and who, by means of the seductions of art, lull to sleep all herd instincts and herd cautiousness in choice spirits; thirdly and finally all those critics and historians who courageously carry forward the happily-begun discovery of the world of antiquity—it is the work of the new Columbus, the German spirit (for we still stand at the beginning of this conquest). For in the world of antiquity there reigned a different, more lordly morality than today; and the man of antiquity, raised in this morality, was a stronger and deeper man than the man of today—he alone has hitherto been “the man that has turned out well.” But the seductive power that antiquity exercises on such well-turned-out, i.e., strong and enterprising, souls is the most subtle and effective of all antidemocratic and anti-Christian influences even today, as at the time of the Renaissance. 958 (1884) I write for a species of man that does not yet exist: for the “masters of the earth.” Religions, as consolations and relaxations, dangerous: man believes he has a right to take his ease. In Plato’s *Theages* it is written: “Each one of us would like to be master over all men, if possible, and best of all God.” This attitude must exist again.44a Englishmen, Americans, and Russians—— 959 (1885-1886)45 The jungle-growth “man” always appears where the struggle for power has been waged the longest. Great men. The Romans—jungle animals. 960 (1885-1886) From now on there will be more favorable preconditions for more comprehensive forms of dominion, whose like has never yet existed. And even this is not the most important thing; the possibility has been established for the production of international racial unions whose task will be to rear a master race, the future “masters of the earth”;—a new, tremendous aristocracy, based on the severest self-legislation, in which the will of philosophical men of power and artist-tyrants will be made to endure for millenia—a higher kind of man who, thanks to their superiority in will, knowledge, riches, and influence, employ democratic Europe as their most pliant and supple instrument for getting hold of the destinies of the earth, so as to work as artists upon “man” himself. Enough: the time is coming when politics will have a different meaning. 961 (1885) To see at which points in history great human beings arise. The significance of protracted despotic moralities: they tense the bow, if they do not break it. 962

(1885) A great man—a man whom nature has constructed and invented in the grand style—what is he? First: there is a long logic in all of his activity, hard to survey because of its length, and consequently misleading; he has the ability to extend his will across great stretches of his life and to despise and reject everything petty about him, including even the fairest, “divinest” things in the world. Secondly: he is colder, harder, less hesitating, and without fear of “opinion”; he lacks the virtues that accompany respect and “respectability,” and altogether everything that is part of the “virtue of the herd.” If he cannot lead, he goes alone; then it can happen that he may snarl at some things he meets on his way. Third: he wants no “sympathetic” heart, but servants, tools; in his intercourse with men he is always intent on making something out of them. He knows he is incommunicable: he finds it tasteless to be familiar; and when one thinks he is, he usually is not. When not speaking to himself, he wears a mask. He rather lies than tells the truth: it requires more spirit and will.⁴⁷ There is a solitude within him that is inaccessible to praise or blame, his own justice that is beyond appeal.

963 (Spring-Fall 1887)

The great man is necessarily a skeptic (which is not to say that he has to appear to be one), provided that greatness consists in this: to will something great and the means to it. Freedom from any kind of conviction is part of the strength of his will. Thus it accords with that “enlightened despotism” exercised by every great passion. Such a passion takes the intellect into its service; it has the courage even for unholy means; it removes scruples; it permits itself convictions, it even needs them, but it does not submit to them. The need for faith, for anything unconditional in Yes and No, is a proof of weakness; all weakness is weakness of will. The man of faith, the believer, is necessarily a small type of man. Hence “freedom of spirit,” i.e., unbelief as an instinct [is a precondition of greatness.]⁴⁹

964 (1884) The great man feels his power over a people, his temporary coincidence with a people or a millenium; this enlargement in his experience of himself as *causa* and *voluntas* is misunderstood as “altruism”; it drives him to seek means of communication: all great men are inventive in such means. They want to embed themselves in great communities; they want to give a single form to the multifarious and disordered; chaos stimulates them. Misunderstanding of love. There is a slavish love that submits and gives itself; that idealizes, and deceives itself—there is a divine love that despises and loves, and reshapes and elevates the beloved. To gain that tremendous energy of greatness in order to shape the man of the future through breeding and, on the other hand, the annihilation of millions of failures, and not to perish of the suffering one creates, though nothing like it has ever existed!—

965 (1884) The revolution, confusion, and distress of peoples is, in my view, inferior to the distress of great individuals during their development. One must not let oneself be deceived: the many distresses of all the small constitute a sum only in the feelings of powerful human beings.— To think of oneself in moments of great danger, to derive advantage from the disadvantage of many: this can be, in the case of a very high degree of deviation, a sign of a great character who manages to master his compassionate and just impulses.

966 (1884) In contrast to the animals, man has cultivated an abundance of contrary drives and impulses within himself: thanks to this synthesis, he is master of the earth.— Moralities are the expression of locally limited orders of rank in his multifarious world of drives, so man should not perish through their contradictions. Thus a drive as master, its opposite weakened, refined, as the impulse that provides the stimulus for the activity of the chief drive. The highest man would have the greatest multiplicity of drives, in the relatively greatest strength that can be endured. Indeed, where the plant “man” shows himself strongest one finds instincts that conflict powerfully (e.g., in Shakespeare), but are controlled.

967 (1885) Whether one does not have the right to account all great men evil? This cannot be shown in a pure state in all

individual cases. Often they have been capable of masterly dissimulation and assumed the outward forms and gestures of great virtues. Often they honored virtue seriously and with a passionate hardness against themselves, but out of cruelty: seen from a distance, this is deceptive. Many misunderstood themselves; not infrequently a great task calls forth great qualities, e.g., justice. The essential point is: the greatest perhaps also possess great virtues, but in that case also their opposites. I believe that it is precisely through the presence of opposites and the feelings they occasion that the great man, the bow with the great tension, develops. 968 (1886-1887) In great men, the specific qualities of life—injustice, falsehood, exploitation—are at their greatest. But in so far as they have had an overwhelming effect, their essence has been most misunderstood and interpreted as goodness. Type: Carlyle as interpreter.50

969 (Spring-Fall 1887)

In general, every thing is worth as much as one has paid for it. This does not hold, to be sure, if one takes the individual in isolation; the great capabilities of the individual are utterly out of proportion to what he himself has done, sacrificed, and suffered for them. But if one considers his family history, one discovers the history of a tremendous storing up and capital accumulation of strength through all kinds of renunciation, struggle, work, and prevailing. It is because the great man has cost so much, and not because he appears as a miracle and gift of heaven and “chance,” that he has become great: “heredity” a false concept. One’s forebears have paid the price for what one is. 970 (1883-1888) Danger in modesty.— To adapt ourselves too early to the tasks, societies, everyday life and everyday work, in which chance has placed us, at a time when neither our strength nor our goal has yet entered our consciousness with the force of law; the all-too-early certainty of conscience, comfortableness, sociability thus achieved, this premature resignation that insinuates itself into our feelings as a release from inner and outer unrest, pampers and holds one back in the most dangerous fashion. To learn to feel respect after the fashion of “those like us,” as if we ourselves had no measure in us and no right to determine values; the effort to evaluate as others do, against the inner voice of our taste, which is also a form of conscience, becomes a terrible, subtle constraint: if there is not finally an explosion, with a sudden bursting asunder of all the bonds of love and morality, then such a spirit becomes withered, petty, effeminate, and factual. The opposite is bad enough, but better nonetheless: to suffer from one’s environment, from its praise as well as from its blame, wounded by it and festering inwardly without betraying the fact; to defend oneself with involuntary mistrust against its love, to learn silence, perhaps concealing it behind speech,⁵¹ to create for oneself nooks and undiscoverable solitudes for moments of relief, of tears, of sublime consolation—until one is finally strong enough to say, “what do I have to do with you?” and to go one’s own way.

971 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Men who are destinies, who by bearing themselves bear destinies, the whole species of heroic bearers of burdens: oh how they would like to rest from themselves for once! how they thirst for strong hearts and necks, so as to be free from what oppresses them, at least for a few hours! And how vainly they thirst! — They wait; they look at everything that passes: no one approaches them with as much as a thousandth part of their suffering and passion,⁵³ no one divines in what way they are waiting—At length, at length they learn their first piece of worldly prudence—not to wait any more; and soon another one: to be genial, to be modest, from now on to endure everyone, to endure everything—in short, to endure even a little more than they have endured so far. 97254 (1884) Legislators of the future.— After having tried in vain for a long time to attach a definite concept to the word “philosopher”— for I found many contradictory characteristics—I recognized at last that there are two distinct kinds of philosopher: those who want to ascertain a complex fact of evaluations (logical or moral); those who are legislators of such evaluations. The former try to master the world of the present or the past by concentrating and abridging the multiplicity of events through signs: their aim is to make previous events surveyable, comprehensible, graspable, and usable—they assist the task of man to employ all past things for the benefit of his future. The latter, however, are commanders; they say: “Thus it shall be!” They alone determine the “whither” and the “wherefore,” what is useful and what constitutes utility for men; they dispose of the preparatory work of scientific men, and all knowledge is for them only a means for creation. This second kind of philosopher rarely prospers; and their situation and danger is indeed fearful. How often they have deliberately blindfolded themselves simply so as not to have to behold the narrow ledge that separates them from a plunge into the abyss; e.g. Plato, when he convinced himself that the “good” as he desired it was not the good of Plato but the “good in itself,” the eternal treasure that some man, named Plato, had chanced to discover on his way! This same will to blindness dominates the founders of religions in a much coarser form: their “thou shalt” must not by any means sound in their ears like “I will”— they dare to fulfill their task only as the command of a god; only as an “inspiration” is their value legislation a bearable burden under which their conscience is not crushed. As soon as these two means of comfort, that of Plato and that of Mohammed, have fallen away and no thinker can relieve his conscience with the hypothesis of a “god” or “eternal values,” the claim of the legislator of new values rises to a new fearfulness never yet attained. From then on, those elect on whom the suspicion of having such a duty begins to dawn, try to see if they cannot, “at the right moment,” elude it, as their greatest danger, through some kind of detour; for example, by convincing themselves that the

task has already been accomplished, or cannot be accomplished, or that their shoulders are not strong enough for such burdens, or that they are already overburdened with other, more immediate tasks, or that even this new, distant duty is a seduction and temptation, drawing them away from all other duties, a sickness, a kind of madness. Many may indeed succeed in eluding it: history is full of the traces of men who have eluded this task, and of their bad consciences. Usually, however, there came to these men of fate that redeeming hour, that autumnal hour of ripeness, in which they had to do what they did not even “want” to do—and the deed of which they had hitherto been most afraid fell easily and unsought from the tree, as an involuntary deed, almost as a gift.— 973 (1885) The human horizon.— One can conceive philosophers as those who make the most extreme efforts to test how far man could elevate himself— Plato especially: how far his strength will reach. But they do it as individuals; perhaps the instinct of the Caesars, of founders of states, etc, was greater, as they pondered how far man might be driven in his evolution and under “favorable conditions.” But they had an insufficient understanding of the nature of favorable circumstances. Great question: where has the plant “man” hitherto grown up most magnificently? For this question the study of comparative history is necessary.

974 (Fall 1888)

A fact, a work is eloquent in a new way for every age and every new type of man. History always enunciates new truths. 975 (1885-1886) To remain objective, hard, firm, severe in carrying through an idea—artists succeed best in this; but when one needs men for this (as teachers, statesmen, etc., do), then the repose and coldness and hardness soon vanish. With natures like Caesar and Napoleon, one gets some notion of “disinterested” work on their marble, whatever the cost in men. On this road lies the future of the highest men: to bear the greatest responsibility and not collapse under it.— Hitherto, the delusions of inspiration were almost always needed in order not to lose one’s faith in one’s right and one’s hand. 976 (1884) Why the philosopher rarely turns out well. His requirements include qualities that usually destroy a man: a tremendous multiplicity of qualities; he must be a brief abstract of man, of all man’s higher and lower desires: danger from antitheses, also from disgust at himself; he must be inquisitive in the most various directions: danger of going to pieces; he must be just and fair in the highest sense, but profound in love, hate (and injustice), too; he must be not only a spectator, but also a legislator: judge and judged (to the extent that he is a brief abstract of the world); extremely multifarious, yet firm and hard. Supple. 977 (1885) The really royal calling of the philosopher (as expressed by Alcuin the Anglo-Saxon): *prava corrigere, et recta corroborare, et sancta sublimare*.⁵⁵ 978 (1885) The new philosopher can arise only in conjunction with a ruling caste, as its highest spiritualization. Great politics, rule over the earth, are at hand; complete lack of the principles that are needed. 979 (1885) Fundamental thought: the new values must first be created— we shall not be spared this task! For us the philosopher must be a legislator. New types. (How the highest types hitherto [e.g., Greeks] were reared: to will this type of “chance” consciously.) 980⁵⁶ (1885) Assuming one thinks of a philosopher as a great educator, powerful enough to draw up to his lonely height a long chain of generations, then one must also grant him the uncanny privileges of the great educator. An educator never says what he himself thinks, but always only what he thinks of a thing in relation to the requirements of those he educates He must not be detected in this dissimulation; it is part of his mastery that one believes in his honesty. He must be capable of employing every means of discipline:⁵⁷ some he can drive toward the heights only with the whips of scorn; others, who are sluggish, irresolute, cowardly, vain, perhaps only with exaggerated praise. Such an educator is beyond good and evil; but no one must know it.

981 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Not to make men “better,” not to preach morality to them in any form, as if “morality in itself,” or any ideal kind of man, were given; but to create conditions that require stronger men who for their part need, and consequently will have, a morality (more clearly: a physical-spiritual discipline) that makes them strong! Not to allow oneself to be misled by blue eyes or heaving bosoms: greatness of soul has nothing romantic about it. And unfortunately nothing at all amiable. 982 (1884) One must learn from war: (1) to associate death with the interests for which one fights—that makes us venerable; (2) one must learn to sacrifice many and to take one’s cause seriously enough not to spare men; (3) rigid discipline, and to permit oneself force and cunning in war. 983 (1884) Education in those rulers’ virtues that master even one’s benevolence and pity: the great cultivator’s virtues (“forgiving one’s enemies” is child’s play by comparison), the affect of the creator must be elevated—no longer to work on marble!—The exceptional situation and powerful position of those beings (compared with any prince hitherto): the Roman Caesar with Christ’s soul.⁵⁹ 984 (1884) Greatness of soul is inseparable from greatness of spirit.⁶⁰ For it involves independence; but in the absence of spiritual greatness, independence ought not to be allowed, it causes mischief, even through its desire to do good and practice “justice.” Small spirits must obey—hence cannot possess greatness. 985 (1885) The higher philosophical man, who has solitude not because he wishes to be alone but because he is something that finds no equals: what dangers and new sufferings have been reserved for him precisely today, when one has unlearned belief in order of rank and consequently does not know how to honor and understand this solitude! Formerly the sage almost sanctified himself in the mind of the crowd by going apart in this way—today the hermit sees himself surrounded as if by a cloud of gloomy doubts and suspicions. And not merely on the part of the envious and wretched: he must sense misunderstanding, neglect, and superficiality even in all benevolence shown him. He knows that crafty cunning of narrow-minded pity that feels itself good and holy when it tries to “save” him from himself, perhaps by means of more comfortable situations or more orderly, more reliable company—indeed, he will have to admire the unconscious instinct of destruction with which all the spiritually mediocre go to work against him, with a perfect faith in their right to do so! It is necessary for these men of incomprehensible loneliness to wrap themselves vigorously and boldly in the cloak of external, spatial solitude, too: that is part of their prudence. Even cunning and disguise are needed today if such a man is to preserve himself, to keep himself aloft, in the midst of the dangerous, down-dragging currents of the age. Every attempt to endure in the present, to endure the present, every approach to the men and aims of today, he will have to atone as if it were his own

special sin; and he may marvel at the concealed wisdom of his nature that, after every such attempt, at once draws him back to himself by means of sickness and bad accidents. 986 (1885) “—Maledetto colui che contrista un spirto immortal!”⁶¹ MANZONI (Conte di Carmagnola, ACT II). 987 (1884)⁶² The most difficult and highest form of man will succeed most rarely: thus the history of philosophy reveals a superabundance of failures, of accidents, and an extremely slow advance; whole millennia intervene and overwhelm what had been achieved; the continuity is broken again and again. It is an appalling history — the history of the highest man, the sage.— What is most harmed is precisely the memory of the great, for the semi-failures and the failures misunderstand them and vanquish them by means of “successes.” Every time “an influence” shows itself, a mob crowds upon the scene; the chatter of the petty and the poor in spirit is a terrible torment for the ears of those who remember with a shudder that the destiny of humanity depends upon the attainment of its highest type. From my childhood I have pondered the conditions for the existence of the sage, and I will not conceal my joyous conviction that he is again becoming possible in Europe—perhaps only for a short time. 988 (1885) We new philosophers, however, not only do we start by describing the actual order of rank and differences in the value of men, we also desire precisely the opposite of an assimilation, an equalization:⁶³ we teach estrangement in every sense, we open up gulfs such as have never existed before, we desire that man should become more evil than he has ever been before. In the meantime, we are still strangers to and from one another. We have many reasons to be hermits and to put on masks—we shall therefore be poor at looking for those like us. We shall live alone and probably suffer the torments of all seven solitudes. But if we should come across one another, one may wager that we mistake or mutually deceive one another.

989 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Les philosophes ne sont pas faits pour s'aimer. Les aigles ne volent point en compagnie. Il faut laisser cela aux perdrix, aux étourneaux.... Planer au-dessus et avoir des griffes, voilà le lot des grands génies.⁶⁴ GALIANI. 990 (1885) I forgot to say that such philosophers are cheerful and that they like to sit in the abyss below a perfectly clear sky: they need different means from other men for enduring life; for they suffer differently (namely, as much from the profundity of their contempt for man as from their love for man).— The most suffering animal on earth invented for itself—laughter. 991 (1885-1886) On the misunderstanding of “cheerfulness.” Temporary relief from a protracted tension; the high spirits, the saturnalia of a spirit that is dedicating and preparing itself for protracted and terrible decisions. The “fool” in the form of “science.”

992 (March-June 1888)

New order of rank of spirits: the tragic natures no longer to the fore. 993 (1885)
It is a comfort to me to know that above the steam and filth of human lowlands there is a higher, brighter humanity, very small in number (for everything outstanding is by its nature rare) : one belongs to it, not because one is more talented or more virtuous or more heroic or more loving than the men below, but —because one is colder, brighter, more far-seeing, more solitary; because one endures, prefers, demands solitude as happiness, as privilege, indeed as a condition of existence; because one lives among clouds and lightning as among one's own kind, but equally among rays of sunlight, drops of dew, flakes of snow, and everything that necessarily comes from the heights and, when it moves, moves eternally only in the direction from above to below. Aspirations toward the heights are not ours.— Heroes, martyrs, geniuses and enthusiasts are not still, patient, subtle, cold, slow enough for us.

994 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Absolute conviction: that value feelings above and below are different; that countless experiences are lacking in those below; that between below and above misunderstanding is necessary. 995 (1884) How do men attain great strength and a great task? All the virtues and efficiency of body and soul are acquired laboriously and little by little, through much industry, self-constraint, limitation, through much obstinate, faithful repetition of the same labors, the same renunciations; but there are men who are the heirs and masters of this slowly-acquired manifold treasure of virtue and efficiency—because, through fortunate and reasonable marriages, and also through fortunate accidents, the acquired and stored-up energies of many generations have not been squandered and dispersed but linked together by a firm ring and by will. In the end there appears a man, a monster of energy, who demands a monster of a task. For it is our energy that disposes of us; and the wretched spiritual game of goals and intentions and motives is only a foreground—even though weak eyes may take them for the matter itself. 996 (1885-1886) The sublime man has the highest value, even if he is terribly delicate and fragile, because an abundance of very difficult and rare things has been bred and preserved together through many generations. 997 (1884) I teach: that there are higher and lower men, and that a single individual can under certain circumstances justify the existence of whole millennia—that is, a full, rich, great, whole human being in relation to countless incomplete fragmentary men. 998 (1884) The highest men live beyond the rulers, freed from all bonds; and in the rulers they have their instruments. 999 (1884) Order of rank: He who determines values and directs the will of millenia by giving direction to the highest natures is the highest man. 1000 (1884) I believe I have guessed some of the things in the soul of the highest man; perhaps anyone who unriddles him must perish; but whoever has seen him must help to make him possible. Fundamental thought: we must consider the future as decisive for all our evaluations—and not seek the laws of our actions behind us! 1001 (1884) Not “mankind” but overman is the goal!

1002 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Come l'uom s'eterna—65 INF. XV 85 See also section 386 above, and Zarathustra IV, “On the Higher Man,” section 5 (Portable Nietzsche, p. 400), as well as III, “The Convalescent,” section 2 (ibid, p. 330 f). 7a See the Appendix, below. 12 “In the MS, underlined, ‘For the third essay.’ Refers to the planned continuation of the Genealogy, which was supposed to comprise three further essays” (1911, p 512) 16 “Lazzarone, a name now often applied generally to beggars, is an Italian term, particularly used of the poorest class of Neapolitans, who, without any fixed abode, live by odd jobs and fishing, but chiefly by begging” (Encyclopaedia Britannica, 11th ed, article on “Lazar”). 19a Cf. Zarathustra I, “On Free Death,” and Twilight, “Skirmishes,” section 36 (Portable Nietzsche, pp 183 ff and 536 f). The idea of the non ecclesiastical monastery was developed by Hermann Hesse in his Nobel Prize winning novel, *Das Glasperlenspiel* (The Bead Game, also translated as *Magister Ludi*). 20 “Charm” (Anmut) represents a doubtful reading. Cf. also Jean-Marie Guyau, *Esquisse d’une morale sans obligation ni sanction* (F. Alcan, Paris 1885), p. 212: “Il y avait donc dans le pari de Pascal un élément qu’il n’a pas mis en lumière. Il n’a guère vu que la crainte du risque, il n’a pas vu le plaisir du risque” (There is in the wager of Pascal an element he did not make clear He saw only the fear of risk, he did not see the pleasure of risk) 30 “Subtlety”: uncertain reading. 32 “Tribe of freedmen, tribes of slaves torn from our hands, tributary people, new people, license has been granted to you to be free, but not to us to be noble; for us everything is a right, for you everything is a matter of grace; we are not part of your community; we are entire by ourselves.” 36 “The Almanach de Gotha, which has existed since 1763, published since 1871 both in French and German, gives a particular account of all the royal and princely families of Europe ...” (Encyclopaedia Britannica, 11th ed., vol I, p. 712). The word von is the mark of nobility in this sense, and when Friedrich Schiller, for example, was elevated to the nobility his name became Friedrich von Schiller. 44a This dialogue is now usually attributed to “an imitator of Plato”; e g, by W D Ross in *The Oxford Classical Dictionary* (Clarendon Press, Oxford 1949), p 891. But see the chapter on “Theages” in Paul Friedländer, *Plato*, vol II (2nd rev ed, Walter de Gruyter, Berlin 1957), especially pp. 141 f and 301 f There is a similar passage in Plato’s *Theaetetus* 176 This whole matter, of course, transcends philological niceties; what is at stake is one of the most crucial points of Nietzsche’s philosophy: he was not an irrationalist And all the men he most admired were, without exception, great intellects—but not merely great intellects. Cf. sections 876 ff above. II. DIONYSUS

1003 (Jan-Fall 1888)

To him that has turned out well, who does my heart good, carved from wood that is hard, gentle, and fragrant—in whom even the nose takes pleasure—this book is dedicated. He enjoys the taste of what is wholesome for him; his pleasure in anything ceases when the bounds of the wholesome are crossed; he divines the remedies for partial injuries; he has illnesses as great stimulants of his life; he knows how to exploit ill chances; he grows stronger through the accidents that threaten to destroy him; he instinctively gathers from all that he sees, hears, experiences, what advances his main concern—he follows a principle of selection—he allows much to fall through; he reacts with the slowness bred by a long caution and a deliberate pride—he tests a stimulus for its origin and its intentions, he does not submit; he is always in his own company, whether he deals with books, men, or landscapes; he honors by choosing, by admitting, by trusting.

1004 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

To attain a height and bird's eye view, so one grasps how everything actually happens as it ought to happen; how every kind of "imperfection" and the suffering to which it gives rise are part of the highest desirability.

1005 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Around 1876 I was terrified to see all I had desired hitherto compromised, as I grasped which way Wagner was going now; and I was bound very closely to him by all the bonds of a profound identity of needs, by gratitude, by his irreplaceability and the absolute privation I saw before me. At the same time I seemed to myself irrevocably incarcerated in my philology and teaching—in an accident and makeshift of my life: I no longer knew how to extricate myself, and was weary, spent, used up. At the same time I grasped that my instinct went into the opposite direction from Schopenhauer's: toward a justification of life, even at its most terrible, ambiguous, and mendacious; for this I had the formula "Dionysian." Against the theory that an "in-itself of things" must necessarily be good, blessed, true, and one, Schopenhauer's interpretation of the "in-itself" as will was an essential step; but he did not understand how to deify this will: he remained entangled in the moral-Christian ideal. Schopenhauer was still so much subject to the dominion of Christian values that, as soon as the thing-in-itself was no longer "God" for him, he had to see it as bad, stupid, and absolutely reprehensible. He failed to grasp that there can be an infinite variety of ways of being different, even of being god.⁶⁶

1006 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Moral values have hitherto been the highest values: would anybody call this in question?— If we remove these values from this position, we alter all values: the principle of their order of rank hitherto is thus overthrown.

1007 (Spring-Fall 1887)

To revalue values—what would that mean? All the spontaneous—new, future, stronger—movements must be there; but they still appear under false names and valuations and have not yet become conscious of themselves. A courageous becoming-conscious and affirmation of what has been achieved—a liberation from the slovenly routine of old valuations that dishonor us in the best and strongest things we have achieved.

1008 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Every doctrine for which all accumulated energies and explosives are not yet ready at hand, is superfluous. A revaluation of values is achieved only when there is a tension of new needs, of men with new needs, who suffer from the old values without attaining this consciousness.

1009 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Points of view for my values: whether out of abundance or out of want?⁶⁷—whether one looks on or lends a hand—or looks away and walks off?⁶⁸—whether out of stored-up energy, “spontaneously,” or merely stimulated reactively, and provoked? whether simple, out of a paucity of elements, or out of overwhelming mastery over many, so they are pressed into service when they are needed?—whether one is a problem or a solution?—whether perfect with a small task or imperfect with an extraordinary goal? whether one is genuine or merely an actor, whether one is genuine as an actor or merely a copy of an actor, whether one is a “representative” or that which is represented?⁶⁹ whether a “personality” or merely a rendezvous of personalities—whether sick from sickness or excessive health? whether one goes on ahead as a shepherd or as an “exception” (third species: as a fugitive)?⁷⁰ whether one needs dignity, or to be a “buffoon”? whether one seeks resistance or avoids it? whether one is imperfect through being “too early” or “too late”? whether by nature one says Yes or No or is a peacock’s tail of many colors? whether one is sufficiently proud not to be ashamed even of one’s vanity? whether one is still capable of a bite of conscience? (—this species is becoming rare: formerly the conscience had too much to chew: now it seems to have lost its teeth)?⁷¹ whether one is still capable of a “duty”? (—there are those who would lose their whole joy in living if their duty were taken from them—especially the womanly, the born subjects.) 1010 (1883-1888) Suppose our usual conception of the world were a misunderstanding: could a form of perfection be conceived within which even such misunderstandings would receive their sanction? Conception of a new perfection: that which does not correspond to our logic, our “beautiful,” our “good,” our “true,” could be perfect in a higher sense than even our ideal.

1011 (Manuscript source uncertain)

Our great renunciation: not to deify the unknown; we are just beginning to know little. False and wasted endeavors. Our “new world”: we have to realize to what degree we are the creators of our value feelings—and thus capable of projecting “meaning” into history. This faith in truth attains its ultimate conclusion in us—you know what it is: that if there is anything that is to be worshipped it is appearance that must be worshipped, that the lie—and not the truth—is divine!

1012 (1883-1888) Whoever pushes rationality forward also restores new strength to the opposite power, mysticism and folly of all kinds. To distinguish in every movement (1) that it is in part exhaustion from a preceding movement (satiety from it, the malice of weakness toward it, sickness); (2) that it is in part newly-awakened, long slumbering, accumulated energy—joyous, exuberant, violent: health. 1013 (1885-1886) Health and sickliness: one should be careful! The standard remains the efflorescence of the body, the agility, courage, and cheerfulness of the spirit—but also, of course, how much of the sickly it can take and overcome—how much it can make healthy. That of which more delicate men would perish belongs to the stimulants of great health. 1014 (1885) It is only a question of strength: to have all the morbid traits of the century, but to balance them through a superabundant, recuperative strength. The strong man.

1015 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

On the strength of the nineteenth century.— We are more medieval than the eighteenth century; not merely more curious about or easily stimulated by the strange and rare. We have revolted against the Revolution— We have emancipated ourselves from fear of reason, the ghost that haunted the eighteenth century: we again dare to be absurd, childish, lyrical—in one word: “we are musicians.” We are as little afraid of the ridiculous as of the absurd. The devil finds that the tolerance of God works in his favor: even more, he is interesting as one who has been misunderstood and slandered from of old—we rescue the honor of the devil. We no longer separate the great from the terrible. We include together the good things, in their complexity, and the worst things: we have overcome the absurd “desirability” of former days (which desired increase of the good without increase of the evil). Cowardice before the ideal of the Renaissance has receded—we even dare to aspire to its mores. Intolerance toward the priest and the church has come to an end at the same time; “it is immoral to believe in God”—but precisely this seems to us the best justification of such faith. We have granted all these things their rights. We are not afraid of the reverse side of “good things” (—we seek them: we are brave and curious enough); e g, of Hellenism, of morality, of reason, of good taste (we compute the losses one sustains with all such precious things: one almost makes oneself poor with such a precious thing —). Just as little do we conceal from ourselves the reverse side of bad things.

1016 (March-June 1888)

What does us honor.— If anything does us honor, it is this: we have transferred seriousness: we regard as important the lowly things that have at all times been despised and left aside—on the other hand, we let “beautiful feelings” go cheap. Is there a more dangerous aberration than contempt for the body? As if it did not condemn all spirituality to become sickly—to the vapeurs of “idealism”!

Whatever Christians and idealists have devised has neither rhyme nor reason: we are more radical. We have discovered the “smallest world” as that which is decisive everywhere.⁷² The way our streets are paved, good air in our room,⁷³ food—we grasp their value; we have taken all the necessities of existence seriously and despise all “beautiful-soulism” as a kind of “levity and frivolity.”—What was formerly most despised has been brought to the front.

1017 (Spring-Fall 1887)

In place of the “natural man” of Rousseau, the nineteenth century has discovered a truer image of “man”—it has had the courage to do so.— On the whole, the Christian concept “man” has thus been reinstated. What one has not had the courage for is to call this “man in himself” good and to see in him the guarantee of the future. Neither has one dared to grasp that an increase in the terribleness of man is an accompaniment of every increase in culture; in this, one is still subject to the Christian ideal and takes its side against paganism, also against the Renaissance concept of *virtù*. But the key to culture is not to be found in this way: and in praxi one retains the falsification of history in favor of the “good man” (as if he alone constituted the progress of man) and the socialist ideal (i.e., the residue of Christianity and of Rousseau in the de-Christianized world). The struggle against the eighteenth century: its supreme overcoming by Goethe and Napoleon. Schopenhauer, too, struggles against it; but he involuntarily steps back into the seventeenth century—he is a modern Pascal, with Pascalian value judgments without Christianity. Schopenhauer was not strong enough for a new Yes. Napoleon: insight that the higher and the terrible man necessarily belong together. The “man” reinstated; the woman again accorded her due tribute of contempt and fear. “Totality” as health and highest activity; the straight line, the grand style in action rediscovered; the most powerful instinct, that of life itself, the lust to rule, affirmed. 1018 (1887)⁷⁴ (*Revue des deux mondes*, Feb. 15, 1887. Taine on Napoleon): “Suddenly the *faculté maîtresse* unfolds: the artist enclosed in the politician emerges de sa gaine;⁷⁶ he creates dans l’idéal et l’impossible.⁷⁷ He is once more recognized for what he is: the posthumous brother of Dante and Michelangelo: and in truth, in view of the firm contours of his vision, the intensity, coherence, and inner logic of his dream, the profundity of his meditation, the superhuman grandeur of his conception, he is like them et leur égal: son génie a la même taille et la même structure; il est un des trois esprits souverains de la renaissance italienne.”⁷⁸ Nota bene—Dante, Michelangelo, Napoleon.

1019 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev. Spring-Fall 1888)

On the pessimism of strength — In the inner psychic economy of the primitive man, fear of evil predominates. What is evil? Three things: chance, the uncertain, the sudden. How does primitive man fight against evil?— He conceives it as reason, as power, even as a person. In this way he establishes the possibility of entering into a kind of treaty with it and in general to exercise influence over it in advance—to forestall it. —Another expedient is to assert that its malice and harmfulness is merely appearance one interprets the consequences of chance, of the uncertain and sudden as well meant, as meaningful. —A third means: one interprets the bad above all as “deserved”: one justifies evil as punishment. —In summa one submits to it: the whole religio-moral interpretation is only a form of submission to evil.— The faith that a good meaning lies in evil means to abandon the struggle against it. Now the whole history of culture represents a diminution of this fear of chance, the uncertain, the sudden. For culture means learning to calculate, to think causally, to forestall, to believe in necessity. With the increase of culture, man can do without that primitive form of submission to ills (called religion or morality), that “justification of evil.” Now he makes war on “ills”—he abolishes them. Indeed, a state is possible in which the sense of security and belief in law and calculability enter consciousness in the form of satiety and disgust—while the delight in chance, the uncertain and sudden becomes titillating. Let us dwell a moment on this symptom of highest culture—I call it the pessimism of strength. Man no longer needs a “justification of ills”; “justification” is precisely what he abhors: he enjoys ills *pur, cru*; he finds senseless ills the most interesting. If he formerly had need of a god, he now takes delight in a world disorder without God, a world of chance, to whose essence belong the terrible, the ambiguous, the seductive. In such a state it is precisely the good that needs “justifying,” i.e., it must be founded in evil and danger or involve some great stupidity: then it still pleases. Animality no longer arouses horror; esprit and happy exuberance in favor of the animal in man is in such ages the most triumphant form of spirituality. Man is now strong enough to be ashamed of any faith in God: he may again play the *advocatus diaboli*. If he in *praxi* advocates the preservation of virtue, he does it for reasons that recognize in virtue a subtlety, a cunning, a form of lust for gain and power. This pessimism of strength also ends in a theodicy, i.e., in an absolute affirmation of the world—but for the very reasons that formerly led one to deny it—and in this fashion to a conception of this world as the actually-achieved highest possible ideal.

1020 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

The chief kinds of pessimism: the pessimism of sensibility (excessive irritability with a preponderance of unpleasurable feelings); the pessimism of “unfree will” (in other words: a lack of strength in resisting stimuli); the pessimism of doubt (a distaste for everything firm, for all grasping and touching). The psychological states proper to these can all be observed in the madhouse, even if in a somewhat exaggerated form. Also “nihilism” (the penetrating feeling of —“nothingness”). But where does the moral pessimism of Pascal belong? the metaphysical pessimism of the Vedanta philosophy? the social pessimism of the anarchists (or of Shelley)? the pessimism of sympathy (like that of Leo Tolstoy, Alfred de Vigny)? Are all these not likewise phenomena of decay and sickness? — To give excessive weight to moral values or to fictions of the “beyond” or to social distress or to suffering in general: every such exaggeration of a narrow viewpoint is in itself already a sign of sickness. Likewise the preponderance of No over Yes! What must not be confused with all this: pleasure in saying No and doing No out of a tremendous strength and tension derived from saying Yes—peculiar to all rich and powerful men and ages. A luxury, as it were; also a form of bravery that opposes the terrible; a sympathetic feeling for the terrible and questionable because one is, among other things, terrible and questionable: the Dionysian in will, spirit, taste.

1021 (Manuscript source uncertain)

My Five “No’s” My struggle against the feeling of guilt and the projection of the concept of punishment into the physical and metaphysical world; also into psychology and the interpretation of history. Insight into the moralization of all previous philosophies and valuations. My recognition and identification of the traditional ideal, the Christian, even where the dogmatic form of Christianity has been abandoned. The dangerousness of the Christian ideal lies in its value feelings, in that which can do without conceptual expression: my struggle against latent Christianity (e.g., in music, in socialism). My struggle against the eighteenth century of Rousseau, against his “nature,” his “good man,” his belief in the dominion of feeling—against the softening, weakening, moralization of man: an ideal born of hatred for aristocratic culture; in praxi, the dominion of the feelings of unbridled resentment, devised as a banner for the struggle (—the morality of guilt feelings of the Christian, the morality of resentment a posture of the mob). My struggle against romanticism, in which Christian ideals and the ideals of Rousseau unite, but compounded with a nostalgia for the old days of priestly-aristocratic culture, for virtù, for the “strong human being”—something extremely hybrid; a false and impersonated strong humanity that values extreme states in general and sees in them a symptom of strength (“cult of passion”; an imitation of the most expressive forms, *furor espressivo*, not out of plenitude but out of a lack).— (What in the nineteenth century is born of a relative plenitude, with gusto: cheerful music, etc.; among poets, e.g., Stifter and Gottfried Keller are signs of greater strength, inner well-being, than——. Grand technique and inventiveness, the natural sciences, history (?)⁸⁰: products of relative strength, self-confidence of the nineteenth century.) My struggle against the predominance of the herd instincts now that science makes common cause with them; against the inward hatred with which every kind of order of rank and distance are treated.

1022 (Spring 1887-March 1888)

From the pressure of plenitude, from the tension of forces that continually increase in us and do not yet know how to discharge themselves, there arises a condition like that preceding a storm: the nature we constitute becomes dark. This, too, is “pessimism”—A doctrine that puts an end to such a condition by commanding something or other—a revaluation of values by virtue of which the accumulated forces are shown a way, a whither, so they explode into lightning flashes and deeds—certainly does not need to be a doctrine of happiness: by releasing force that had been compressed and dammed to the point of torment it brings happiness.

1023 (March-June 1888)

Pleasure appears where there is the feeling of power. Happiness: in the triumphant consciousness of power and victory. Progress: the strengthening of the type, the ability for great willing; everything else is misunderstanding, danger.

1024 (Spring-Fall 1887)

A period when the old masquerade and moral decking-up of the affects arouses antipathy: naked nature; where the decisiveness of quanta of power is simply admitted (as determining rank); where the grand style appears again as the consequence of grand passion.

1025 (Spring-Fall 1887)

To press everything terrible into service, one by one, step by step, experimentally: this is what the task of culture demands; but until it is strong enough for this, it must oppose, moderate, veil, even curse all this. Everywhere that a culture posits evil, it gives expression to a relationship of fear, thus a weakness. Thesis: everything good is the evil of former days made serviceable. Standard: the greater and more terrible the passions are that an age, a people, an individual can permit themselves, because they are capable of employing them as means, the higher stands their culture;⁸¹ the more mediocre, the weaker, the more submissive and cowardly a man is, the more he will posit as evil: it is with him that the realm of evil is most comprehensive. The basest man will see the realm of evil (i.e., of that which is forbidden and hostile to him) everywhere.

1026 (Summer-Fall 1883)

Not “happiness follows virtue”—but the more powerful man first designates his happy state as virtue. Evil actions belong to the powerful and virtuous: bad, base ones to the subjected. The most powerful man, the creator, would have to be the most evil, in as much as he carries his ideal against the ideals of other men and remakes them in his own image. Evil here means: hard, painful, enforced. Such men as Napoleon must come again and again and confirm the belief in the autocracy of the individual: but he himself was corrupted by the means he had to employ and lost noblesse of character. If he had had to prevail among a different kind of man he could have employed other means; and it would thus not seem to be a necessity for a Caesar to become bad.

1027 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Man is beast and superbeast;⁸² the higher man is inhuman and superhuman: these belong together. With every increase of greatness and height in man, there is also an increase in depth and terribleness: one ought not to desire the one without the other— or rather: the more radically one desires the one, the more radically one achieves precisely the other.

1028 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Terribleness is part of greatness: let us not deceive ourselves. 1029 (1884-1886) I have presented such terrible images to knowledge that any “Epicurean delight” is out of the question. Only Dionysian joy is sufficient: I have been the first to discover the tragic.⁸³ The Greeks, thanks to their moralistic superficiality, misunderstood it. Even resignation is not a lesson of tragedy, but a misunderstanding of it! Yearning for nothingness is a denial of tragic wisdom, its opposite! 1030 (1883-1888) A full and powerful soul not only copes with painful, even terrible losses, deprivations, robberies, insults; it emerges from such hells with a greater fullness and powerfulness; and, most essential of all, with a new increase in the blissfulness of love. I believe that he who has divined something of the most basic conditions for this growth in love will understand what Dante meant when he wrote over the gate of his *Inferno*: “I, too, was created by eternal love.”⁸⁴

1031 (Spring-Fall 1887)

To explore the whole sphere of the modern soul, to have sat in its every nook—my ambition, my torture, and my happiness. Really to overcome pessimism—a Goethean eye full of love and good will as the result. 1032 (1883-1885)⁸⁵ The first question is by no means whether we are content with ourselves, but whether we are content with anything at all.⁸⁶ If we affirm one single moment, we thus affirm not only ourselves but all existence.⁸⁷ For nothing is self-sufficient, neither in us ourselves nor in things; and if our soul has trembled with happiness and sounded like a harp string just once, all eternity was needed to produce this one event—and in this single moment of affirmation all eternity was called good, redeemed, justified, and affirmed.

1033 (March-June 1888)

The affirmative affects pride, joy, health, love of the sexes, enmity and war, reverence, beautiful gestures and manners,⁸⁸ strong will, the discipline of high spirituality, will to power, gratitude toward earth and life—everything that is rich and desires to bestow and that replenishes and gilds and immortalizes and deifies life—the whole force of transfiguring virtues, everything that declares good and affirms in word and deed— 1034 (1888) We few or many who again dare to live in a dismoralized world, we pagans in faith: we are probably also the first to grasp what a pagan faith is:—to have to imagine higher creatures than man, but beyond good and evil; to have to consider all being higher as also being immoral. We believe in Olympus—and not in the “Crucified.”

1035 (Spring-Fall 1887; rev Spring-Fall 1888)

Latter-day man has employed his power of idealization in regard to a god chiefly to make the god more and more moral. What does that signify?—Nothing good, a diminution of the strength of man. For in itself the opposite would be possible; and there are indications of this. God conceived as an emancipation from morality, taking into himself the whole fullness of life's antitheses and, in a divine torment, redeeming and justifying them: God as the beyond and above of the wretched loafers' morality of "good and evil." 1036 (1885-1886) A humanitarian God cannot be demonstrated from the world we know: today you can be compelled to admit this much. But what conclusions do you draw?⁸⁹ "He cannot be demonstrated to us": epistemological skepticism. You are all afraid of the conclusion: "from the world we know, a very different god would be demonstrable, one who at any rate is not humanitarian"—and, in short, you hold fast to your God and devise for him a world we do not know.

1037 (Spring-Fall 1887)

Let us remove supreme goodness from the concept of God: it is unworthy of a god. Let us also remove supreme wisdom: it is the vanity of philosophers that is to be blamed for this mad notion of God as a monster of wisdom: he had to be as like them as possible. No! God the supreme power—that suffices! Everything follows from it, “the world” follows from it! 1038 (March-Fall 1888)⁹⁰ —And how many new gods are still possible! As for myself, in whom the religious, that is to say god-forming, instinct occasionally becomes active at impossible times—how differently, how variously the divine has revealed itself to me each time! So many strange things have passed before me in those timeless moments that fall into one’s life as if from the moon, when one no longer has any idea how old one is or how young one will yet be—I should not doubt that there are many kinds of gods— There are some one cannot imagine without a certain halcyon and frivolous quality in their make-up— Perhaps light feet are even an integral part of the concept “god”— Is it necessary to elaborate that a god prefers to stay beyond everything bourgeois and rational? and, between ourselves, also beyond good and evil? His prospect is free—in Goethe’s words.⁹¹— And to call upon the inestimable authority of Zarathustra in this instance: Zarathustra goes so far as to confess: “I would believe only in a God who could dance”— To repeat: how many new gods are still possible!— Zarathustra himself, to be sure, is merely an old atheist: he believes neither in old nor in new gods. Zarathustra says he would; but Zarathrusta will not— Do not misunderstand him. The type of God after the type of creative spirits, of “great men.”

1039 (March-June 1888)

And how many new ideals are, at bottom, still possible!— Here is a little ideal I stumble upon once every five weeks on a wild and lonely walk, in an azure moment of sinful happiness. To spend one's life amid delicate and absurd things; a stranger to reality; half an artist, half a bird and metaphysician; with no care for reality, except now and then to acknowledge it in the manner of a good dancer with the tips of one's toes; always tickled by some sunray of happiness; exuberant and encouraged even by misery—for misery preserves the happy man; fixing a little humorous tail even to the holiest things: this, as is obvious, is the ideal of a heavy, hundredweight spirit—a spirit of gravity.

1040 (Summer-Fall 1888)

From the soul's school of war.⁹² (Dedicated to the brave, the cheerful, the temperate.) I should not like to undervalue the amiable virtues; but greatness of soul is not compatible with them. Even in the arts, the grand style excludes the pleasing. * In times of painful tension and vulnerability, choose war: it hardens, it produces muscles. * The deeply wounded have Olympian laughter; one has only what one needs to have. * It has been ten years already: not a sound reaches me any longer—a land without rain. One must have a great deal of humanity left not to die of thirst in the drought. 1041 (1888) My new path to a “Yes”.—Philosophy, as I have hitherto understood and lived it, is a voluntary quest for even the most detested and notorious sides of existence. From the long experience I gained from such a wandering through ice and wilderness, I learned to view differently all that had hitherto philosophized: the hidden history of philosophy, the psychology of its great names, came to light for me. “How much truth can a spirit endure, how much truth does a spirit dare?”—this became for me the real standard of value Error is cowardice—every achievement of knowledge is a consequence of courage, of severity toward oneself, of cleanliness toward oneself— Such an experimental philosophy as I live anticipates experimentally even the possibilities of the most fundamental nihilism; but this does not mean that it must halt at a negation, a No, a will to negation. It wants rather to cross over to the opposite of this—to a Dionysian affirmation of the world as it is, without subtraction, exception, or selection—it wants the eternal circulation:—the same things, the same logic and illogic of entanglements. The highest state a philosopher can attain: to stand in a Dionysian relationship to existence—my formula for this is *amor fati* It is part of this state to perceive not merely the necessity of those sides of existence hitherto denied, but their desirability; and not their desirability merely in relation to the sides hitherto affirmed (perhaps as their complement or precondition), but for their own sake, as the more powerful, more fruitful, truer sides of existence, in which its will finds clearer expression. It is also part of this state to depreciate that side of existence which alone has been affirmed hitherto; to perceive the origin of this valuation and how little a Dionysian value standard for existence is obliged to it: I pulled up and perceived what it really was that here affirmed (on one hand, the instinct of the suffering; on the other the instinct of the herd; and thirdly, the instinct of the majority against the exceptions—). Thus I guessed to what extent a stronger type of man would necessarily have to conceive the elevation and enhancement of man as taking place in another direction: higher beings, beyond good and evil, beyond those values which cannot deny their origin in the sphere of suffering, the herd, and the majority—I sought in history the beginnings of this construction of reverse ideals (the concepts “pagan,” “classical,” “noble”

newly discovered and expounded—). 1042 (1885-1886) To demonstrate to what extent the Greek religion was higher than the Judaeo-Christian. The latter conquered because the Greek religion had become degenerate (had retrogressed). 1043 (1884) It is nothing to be wondered at that a couple of millenia are needed to re-establish contact—a couple of millennia mean little! 1044 (1885-1886) There is a need for those who will sanctify all activities, not only eating and drinking—and not merely in remembrance of them and to become one with them, but this world must be transfigured ever anew and in new ways. 1045 (1886-1887) The most spiritual men feel the stimulus and charm of sensuous things in a way that other men—those with “fleshly hearts”—cannot possibly imagine and ought not to imagine: they are sensualists in the best faith, because they accord the senses a more fundamental value than to that fine sieve, that thinning and reducing machine, or whatever we may call what in the language of the people is named “spirit.” The strength and power of the senses—this is the essential thing in a well-constituted and complete man: the splendid “animal” must be given first—what could any “humanization” matter otherwise! 1046 (1884) We want to hold fast to our senses and to our faith in them—and think their consequences through to the end! The nonsensuality of philosophy hitherto as the greatest nonsensicality of man. The existing world, upon which all earthly living things have worked so that it appears as it does (durable and changing slowly), we want to go on building—and not criticize it away as false! Our valuations are a part of this building; they emphasize and underline. Of what significance is it if entire religions say: “all is bad and false and evil”! This condemnation of the entire process can only be a judgment of the ill-constituted! To be sure, the ill-constituted can be the greatest sufferers and the most subtle? The contented could be of little value? One must understand the artistic basic phenomenon that is called “life”—the building spirit that builds under the most unfavorable conditions: in the slowest manner——A demonstration of all its combinations must first be produced afresh: it preserves itself.

1047 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

Sexuality, the lust to rule, pleasure in appearance and deception, great and joyful gratitude for life and its typical states—these are of the essence of the pagan cults and have a good conscience on their side.— Unnaturalness (already in Greek antiquity) fights against the pagan, as morality, as dialectic. 1048 (1885-1886) An anti-metaphysical view of the world—yes, but an artistic one. 1049 (1885-1886) Apollo's deception: the eternity of beautiful form; the aristocratic legislation, "thus shall it be for ever!" Dionysus: sensuality and cruelty. Transitoriness could be interpreted as enjoyment of productive and destructive force, as continual creation.

1050 (March-June 1888)

The word “Dionysian” means: an urge to unity, a reaching out beyond personality, the everyday, society, reality, across the abyss of transitoriness: a passionate-painful overflowing into darker, fuller, more floating states; an ecstatic affirmation of the total character of life as that which remains the same, just as powerful, just as blissful, through all change; the great pantheistic sharing of joy and sorrow that sanctifies and calls good even the most terrible and questionable qualities of life; the eternal will to procreation, to fruitfulness, to recurrence; the feeling of the necessary unity of creation and destruction. The word “Apollinian” means: the urge to perfect self-sufficiency, to the typical “individual,” to all that simplifies, distinguishes, makes strong, clear, unambiguous, typical: freedom under the law. The further development of art is as necessarily tied to the antagonism between these two natural artistic powers as the further development of man is to that between the sexes. Plenitude of power and moderation, the highest form of self-affirmation in a cool, noble, severe beauty: the Apollinianism of the Hellenic will. This antithesis of the Dionysian and the Apollinian within the Greek soul is one of the great riddles to which I felt myself drawn when considering the nature of the Greeks. Fundamentally I was concerned with nothing except to guess why precisely Greek Apollinianism had to grow out of a Dionysian subsoil; why the Dionysian Greek needed to become Apollinian; that is, to break his will to the terrible, multifarious, uncertain, frightful, upon a will to measure, to simplicity, to submission to rule and concept. The immoderate, disorderly Asiatic lies at his roots: the bravery of the Greek consists in his struggle with his Asiaticism; beauty is not given to him, as little as is logic or the naturalness of customs—it is conquered, willed, won by struggle—it is his victory.⁹⁶ 1051 (1885) The highest and most illustrious human joys, in which existence celebrates its own transfiguration, come, as is reasonable, only to the rarest and best-constituted men; and even to these only when they themselves and their ancestors have lived long, preparatory lives directed to this goal, and not even in the knowledge of this goal. Then an overflowing wealth of the most multifarious forces and the most dextrous power of “free willing” and lordly command dwell amicably together in one man; the spirit is then as much at home in the senses as the senses are at home in the spirit; and whatever takes place in the spirit must enkindle a subtle extraordinary happiness and play in the senses. And also the other way around! Consider this reverse process in the case of Hafiz; even Goethe, however much more faintly, gives us an idea of this occurrence. It is probable that with such perfect and well-constituted men the most sensual functions are finally transfigured by a symbol-intoxication of the highest spirituality: they experience a kind of deification of the body in themselves and are as distant as possible from the ascetic philosophy of the

proposition “God is a spirit”—and this shows clearly that the ascetic is the “ill-constituted man,” who calls good only a something-in-itself, and indeed a something that judges and condemns—and also calls it “God.” From that height of joy where man feels himself to be altogether a deified form and a self-justification of nature, down to the joy of healthy peasants and healthy half-human animals, this whole, long, tremendous light and color scale of happiness, the Greeks, not without the grateful shudder of him who is initiated into a mystery, not without much caution and pious silence, called by the divine name: Dionysus.—What do any latter-day men, the children of a fragmentary, multifarious, sick, strange age, know of the range of Greek happiness; what could they know of it! Whence would the slaves of “modern ideas” derive a right to Dionysian festivals! When the Greek body and the Greek soul “bloomed,” and not in conditions of morbid exaltation and madness, there arose that mysterious symbol of the highest world-affirmation and transfiguration of existence that has yet been attained on earth. Here we have a standard by which everything that has grown up since is found too short, too poor, too narrow. One only needs to pronounce the word “Dionysus” in the presence of the best latter-day names and things, in the presence of Goethe perhaps, or Beethoven, or Shakespeare, or Raphael—at once we feel that our best things and moments have been judged. Dionysus is a judge!—Have I been understood? There can be no doubt that the Greeks sought to interpret the ultimate mysteries “of the destiny of the soul” and everything they knew concerning education and purification, above all concerning the immovable order of rank and inequality of value between man and man, on the basis of their Dionysian experiences: here is the great depth, the great silence, in all matters Greek—one does not know the Greeks as long as this hidden subterranean entrance lies blocked. Importunate scholar’s eyes will never see anything in these things, however much scholarship still has to be employed in this excavation. Even the noble zeal of such friends of antiquity as Goethe and Winckelmann here has something unpermitted, even immodest about it. To wait and to prepare oneself; to await the emergence of new sources; to prepare oneself in solitude for strange faces and voices; to wash one’s soul ever cleaner from the marketplace dust and noise of this age; to overcome everything Christian through something supra-Christian, and not merely to put it aside—for the Christian doctrine was the counterdoctrine to the Dionysian; to rediscover the South in one and to spread out above one a bright, glittering, mysterious southern sky; to reconquer southern health and hidden powerfulness of soul; step by step to become more comprehensive, more supranational, more European, more Near Eastern, finally more Greek—for the Greek was the first great union and synthesis of everything Near Eastern, and on that account the inception of the

European soul, the discovery of our “new world”: whoever lives under such imperatives, who knows what he may not encounter one day? Perhaps—a new day!

1052 (March-June 1888)

The two types: Dionysus and the Crucified.⁹⁷— To determine: whether the typical religious man [is]⁹⁸ a form of decadence (the great innovators are one and all morbid and epileptic); but are we not here omitting one type of religious man, the pagan? Is the pagan cult not a form of thanksgiving and affirmation of life? Must its highest representative not be an apology for and deification of life? The type of a well-constituted and ecstatically overflowing spirit! The type of a spirit that takes into itself and redeems the contradictions and questionable aspects of existence! It is here I set the Dionysus of the Greeks: the religious affirmation of life, life whole and not denied or in part; (typical—that the sexual act arouses profundity, mystery,¹⁰⁰ reverence). Dionysus versus the “Crucified”: there you have the antithesis. It is not a difference in regard to their martyrdom—it is a difference in the meaning of it. Life itself, its eternal fruitfulness and recurrence, creates torment, destruction, the will to annihilation. In the other case, suffering—the “Crucified as the innocent one”—counts as an objection to this life, as a formula for its condemnation.— One will see that the problem is that of the meaning of suffering: whether a Christian meaning or a tragic meaning. In the former case, it is supposed to be the path to a holy existence; in the latter case, being is counted as holy enough to justify even a monstrous amount of suffering. The tragic man affirms even the harshest suffering: he is sufficiently strong, rich, and capable of deifying to do so. The Christian denies even the happiest lot on earth: he is sufficiently weak, poor, disinherited to suffer from life in whatever form he meets it. The god on the cross is a curse on life, a signpost to seek redemption from life; Dionysus cut to pieces is a promise of life: it will be eternally reborn and return again from destruction.¹⁰² 85 “Above the beginning, the MS has the incomplete sentence: ‘Once one has comprehended, not only in how far every one of our actions is necessary but also how they mutually entail each other and how every nuance of feeling——’ ” (1911, p. 514). These reflections on *The Birth of Tragedy*—apparently in connection with the section on that book in *Ecce Homo*—help our understanding of Nietzsche’s first work. In sum: this section is in many ways typical of the whole book. It was written in extreme haste, and it would be an understatement to say that it was not polished for publication; but for all that it is remarkable—as a document that aids our understanding of Nietzsche, as a prose passage, and for the ideas it expresses. Schlechta’s edition, as usual, does not follow the MS but the standard editions, ignoring the information furnished in 1911 (p 514 in this case). III. THE ETERNAL RECURRENCE 1053 (1884) My philosophy brings the triumphant idea of which all other modes of thought will ultimately perish. It is the great cultivating idea: the races that cannot bear it stand condemned; those who find it the greatest benefit are chosen to rule. 1054 (1885-1886) The greatest of

struggles: for this a new weapon is needed. The hammer: to provoke a fearful decision, to confront Europe with the consequences: whether its will “wills” destruction. Prevention of reduction to mediocrity. Rather destruction! 1055 (1885) A pessimistic teaching and way of thinking, an ecstatic nihilism, can under certain conditions be indispensable precisely to the philosopher—as a mighty pressure and hammer with which he breaks and removes degenerate and decaying races to make way for a new order of life, or to implant into that which is degenerate and desires to die a longing for the end. 1056 (1884) It want to teach the idea that gives many the right to erase themselves—the great cultivating idea. 1057 (1883-1888) The eternal recurrence. A prophecy.¹⁰³ Presentation of the doctrine and its theoretical presuppositions and consequences. Proof of the doctrine. Probable consequences of its being believed (it makes everything break open). a) Means of enduring it; b) Means of disposing of it. Its place in history as a mid-point. Period of greatest danger. Foundation of an oligarchy above peoples and their interests: education to a universally human politics. Counterpart of Jesuitism. 1058 (1883-1888) The two greatest philosophical points of view (devised by Germans) : a) that of becoming, of development. b) that according to the value of existence (but the wretched form of German pessimism must first be overcome!)—both brought together my me in a decisive way. Everything becomes and recurs eternally— escape is impossible! — Supposing we could judge value, what follows? The idea of recurrence as a selective principle, in the service of strength (and barbarism!!). Ripeness of man for this idea. 1059 (1884) The idea [of the eternal recurrence]:¹⁰⁴ the presuppositions that would have to be true if it were true. Its consequences. As the hardest idea: its probable effect if it were not prevented, i.e., if all values were not revalued. Means of enduring it: the revaluation of all values. No longer joy in certainty but in uncertainty; no longer “cause and effect” but the continually creative; no longer will to preservation but to power; no longer the humble expression, “everything is merely subjective,” but “it is also our work!— Let us be proud of it!” 1060 (1884) To endure the idea of the recurrence one needs: freedom from morality; new means against the fact of pain (pain conceived as a tool, as the father of pleasure; there is no cumulative consciousness of displeasure); the enjoyment of all kinds of uncertainty, experimentalism, as a counterweight to this extreme fatalism; abolition of the concept of necessity; abolition of the “will”; abolition of “knowledge-in-itself.” Greatest elevation of the consciousness of strength in man, as he creates the overman. 1061 (1887-1888) The two most extreme modes of thought—the mechanistic and the Platonic—are reconciled in the eternal recurrence: both as ideals. 1062 (1885) If the world had a goal, it must have been reached. If there were for it some unintended final state, this also must have been reached. If it were in any way capable of a pausing and becoming fixed, of “being,” if in the

whole course of its becoming it possessed even for a moment this capability of “being,” then all becoming would long since have come to an end, along with all thinking, all “spirit.” The fact of “spirit” as a form of becoming proves that the world has no goal, no final state, and is incapable of being. The old habit, however, of associating a goal with every event and a guiding, creative God with the world, is so powerful that it requires an effort for a thinker not to fall into thinking of the very aimlessness of the world as intended. This notion—that the world intentionally avoids a goal and even knows artifices for keeping itself from entering into a circular course—must occur to all those who would like to force on the world the ability for eternal novelty, i.e., on a finite, definite, unchangeable force of constant size, such as the world is, the miraculous power of infinite novelty in its forms and states. The world, even if it is no longer a god, is still supposed to be capable of the divine power of creation, the power of infinite transformations; it is supposed to consciously prevent itself from returning to any of its old forms; it is supposed to possess not only the intention but the means of avoiding any repetition; to that end, it is supposed to control every one of its movements at every moment so as to escape goals, final states, repetitions—and whatever else may follow from such an unforgiveably insane way of thinking and desiring. It is still the old religious way of thinking and desiring, a kind of longing to believe that in some way the world is after all like the old beloved, infinite, boundlessly creative God—that in some way “the old God still lives”—that longing of Spinoza which was expressed in the words “*deus sive natura*”¹⁰⁵ (he even felt “*natura sive deus*”). What, then, is the law and belief with which the decisive change, the recently attained preponderance of the scientific spirit over the religious, God-inventing spirit, is most clearly formulated? Is it not: the world, as force, may not be thought of as unlimited, for it cannot be so thought of; we forbid ourselves the concept of an infinite force as incompatible with the concept “force.” Thus—the world also lacks the capacity for eternal novelty. ¹⁰⁶³ (1886-1887) The law of the conservation of energy demands eternal recurrence. ¹⁰⁶⁴ (1885) That a state of equilibrium is never reached proves that it is not possible. But in an indefinite space it would have to have been reached. Likewise in a spherical space. The shape of space must be the cause of eternal movement, and ultimately of all “imperfection.” That “force” and “rest,” “remaining the same,” contradict one another. The measure of force (as magnitude) as fixed, but its essence in flux.¹⁰⁶ “Timelessness” to be rejected. At any precise moment of a force, the absolute conditionality of a new distribution of all its forces is given: it cannot stand still. “Change” belongs to the essence, therefore also temporality: with this, however, the necessity of change has only been posited once more conceptually.

1065 (Nov. 1887-March 1888)

A certain emperor always bore in mind the transitoriness of all things so as not to take them too seriously and to live at peace among them. To me, on the contrary, everything seems far too valuable to be so fleeting: I seek an eternity for everything: ought one to pour the most precious salves and wines into the sea?—My consolation is that everything that has been is eternal: the sea will cast it up again.

1066 (March-June 1888)

The new world-conception.— The world exists; it is not something that becomes, not something that passes away. Or rather: it becomes, it passes away, but it has never begun to become and never ceased from passing away—it maintains itself in both.— It lives on itself: its excrements are its food. We need not worry for a moment about the hypothesis of a created world. The concept “create” is today completely indefinable,¹⁰⁷ unrealizable; merely a word, a rudimentary survival from the ages of superstition; one can explain nothing with a mere word. The last attempt to conceive a world that had a beginning has lately been made several times with the aid of logical procedures—generally, as one may divine, with an ulterior theological motive. Lately one has sought several times to find a contradiction in the concept “temporal infinity of the world in the past” (*regressus in infinitum*): one has even found it, although at the cost of confusing the head with the tail. Nothing can prevent me from reckoning backward from this moment and saying “I shall never reach the end”; just as I can reckon forward from the same moment into the infinite. Only if I made the mistake—I shall guard against it—of equating this correct concept of a *regressus in infinitum* with an utterly unrealizable concept of a finite *progressus* up to this present, only if I suppose that the direction (forward or backward) is logically a matter of indifference, would I take the head—this moment—for the tail: I shall leave that to you, my dear Herr Dühring!— I have come across this idea in earlier thinkers: every time it was determined by other ulterior considerations (— mostly theological, in favor of the creator spiritus). If the world could in any way become rigid, dry, dead, nothing, or if it could reach a state of equilibrium, or if it had any kind of goal that involved duration, immutability, the once-and-for-all (in short, speaking metaphysically: if becoming could resolve itself into being or into nothingness), then this state must have been reached. But it has not been reached: from which it follows— This is the sole certainty we have in our hands to serve as a corrective to a great host of world hypotheses possible in themselves. If, e.g., the mechanistic theory cannot avoid the consequence, drawn for it by William Thomson,¹⁰⁸ of leading to a final state, then the mechanistic theory stands refuted. If the world may be thought of as a certain definite quantity of force and as a certain definite number of centers of force—and every other representation remains indefinite and therefore useless—it follows that, in the great dice game of existence, it must pass through a calculable number of combinations. In infinite time, every possible combination would at some time or another be realized; more: it would be realized an infinite number of times. And since between every combination and its next recurrence all other possible combinations would have to take place, and each of these combinations conditions the entire sequence of combinations in the same series, a circular

movement of absolutely identical series is thus demonstrated: the world as a circular movement that has already repeated itself infinitely often and plays its game in infinitum. This conception is not simply a mechanistic conception; for if it were that, it would not condition an infinite recurrence of identical cases, but a final state. Because the world has not reached this, mechanistic theory must be considered an imperfect and merely provisional hypothesis. 1067109 (1885) And do you know what “the world” is to me? Shall I show it to you in my mirror? This world: a monster of energy, without beginning, without end; a firm, iron magnitude of force that does not grow bigger or smaller, that does not expend itself but only transforms itself; as a whole, of unalterable size, a household without expenses or losses, but likewise without increase or income; enclosed by “nothingness” as by a boundary; not something blurry or wasted, not something endlessly extended, but set in a definite space as a definite force, and not a space that might be “empty” here or there, but rather as force throughout, as a play of forces and waves of forces, at the same time one and many, increasing here and at the same time decreasing there; a sea of forces flowing and rushing together, eternally changing, eternally flooding back, with tremendous years of recurrence, with an ebb and a flood of its forms; out of the simplest forms striving toward the most complex, out of the stillest, most rigid, coldest forms toward the hottest, most turbulent, most self-contradictory, and then again returning home to the simple out of this abundance, out of the play of contradictions back to the joy of concord, still affirming itself in this uniformity of its courses and its years, blessing itself as that which must return eternally, as a becoming that knows no satiety, no disgust, no weariness: this, my Dionysian world of the eternally self-creating, the eternally self-destroying, this mystery world of the twofold voluptuous delight, my “beyond good and evil,” without goal, unless the joy of the circle is itself a goal; without will, unless a ring feels good will toward itself—do you want a name for this world? A solution for all its riddles? A light for you, too, you best-concealed, strongest, most intrepid, most midnightly men?—This world is the will to power—and nothing besides! And you yourselves are also this will to power—and nothing besides! For Nietzsche’s argument see also section 55 above, as well as my Nietzsche, Chapter 11, section II, and my article on Nietzsche in the Encyclopedia of Philosophy, ed Paul Edwards, New York, 1967. A Note on This Edition For the present volume I enlisted as a collaborator R. J. Hollingdale, author of Nietzsche: The Man and His Philosophy (University of Louisiana Press, 1965). I made a new translation of Book I, and he furnished new translations of Books II, III, and IV, which I subsequently corrected and revised very extensively, after comparing them with the original German, sentence for sentence I am also responsible for the notes and the editorial apparatus—indeed, for the volume as a whole. W. K. VINTAGE BOOKS EDITION, September, 1968 © Copyright, 1967, by Walter Kaufmann eISBN:

978-0-307-43474-6 rights reserved under International and Pan-American Copyright Conventions Published in New York by Random House, Inc. acknowledgment is made to the Nationale Forschungs- und Gedenkstätten der Klassischen Deutschen Literatur in Weimar permission to reproduce eight facsimile pages from the original manuscript. v.1 for MARTHA LINDE 1881-1966 On the Editions of THE WILL TO POWER THE FIRST EDITION appeared in 1901 in volume XV of Nietzsche's Werke (in the so-called Grossoktav edition). The title page read N A C H G E L A S S E N E W E R K E. Der Wille zur Macht. Versuch einer Umwerthung aller Werthe. (Studien und Fragmente) VON Friedrich Nietzsche. LEIPZIG Druck und Verlag von C G Naumann The editors were Peter Gast, Ernst Horneffer, and August Horneffer. On the last page of her preface, Nietzsche's sister wrote: "But I emphasize expressly that I myself am not the editor of this volume but at most a collaborator in the most modest sense of that word. The only circumstance that permits me to write this preface is that the collected edition of my brother's works is published at my behest, and hence the heaviest part of the responsibility, with all its cares and fights, has been resting on my shoulders for many years now. This 15th volume is to be considered as the culmination of the perennial, troublesome, conscientious labors of the editors: Peter Gast, Ernst and August Horneffer ..."

483 sections (490 pages) plus 23 pages of Nietzsche's plans, and another 23 pages of editorial notes. The editors did not have time to do the job as they themselves felt it ought to be done, because Elisabeth Förster-Nietzsche, as head of the Nietzsche-Archive, insisted that the volume be published in a hurry. There were recriminations between her and the brothers Horneffer, and they left the Archive. The second edition of 1906, in the so-called Taschen edition of the Werke (for the different editions of the works in German see the bibliography at the end of my translation of *The Birth of Tragedy* and *The Case of Wagner* in one volume, Vintage Books, New York 1967), followed roughly the same plan as the first edition but comprised 1,067 sections. Peter Gast checked all the material against Nietzsche's manuscripts, which he is said to have been able to decipher better than anyone else, and he seems to have had a fairly free hand in Books I and III. The reprint of 1911 (in vols. XV and XVI of the revised edition of the Grossoktav edition) follows the text of 1906, but Dr. Otto Weiss contributed an appendix of invaluable scholarly notes on the manuscripts. In the so-called Musarion edition (23 vols., 1920-29), published by the Musarion Verlag in Munich, the text of 1906 and 1911, which had been published by Kröner in Leipzig, is reprinted in vols. XVIII and XIX, but the apparatus differs in two important respects from the edition of 1911: on the basis of the information given by Dr. Weiss on p. 480 ff, a table is included that furnishes the approximate date of composition for every one of the 1,067 sections; and the editorial notes listing departures from the manuscripts are omitted. Indeed, these notes are found only

in the edition of 1911, and the list of dates appears only in the Musarion edition. These two editions are therefore the most scholarly and helpful, that of 1911 being by far the best. No subsequent edition has made any important scholarly contribution. The editions of Bäumler, Würzbach, and Schlechta are discussed in the Editor's Introduction to the present edition, and the editorial notes contain many examples showing how Schlechta's edition is less faithful to the manuscripts than the edition of 1911, notwithstanding his explicit claims which have been widely taken on credit on both sides of the Atlantic. Finally, it may be noted that Bäumler's first edition of *Der Wille zur Macht*, in volume 78 of Kröners Taschen edition (1930) presented the work as one of Nietzsche's books: the title page mentions no editors. In the reprint in *Sämtliche Werke in zwölf Bänden*, 12 vols., Kröner, Stuttgart 1964-65, the text follows volume 78 with the same pagination, but the title page adds "Ausgewählt und geordnet von Peter Gast unter Mitwirkung von Elisabeth Förster-Nietzsche" (selected and arranged by Peter Gast with the aid of Elisabeth Förster-Nietzsche); and in a postscript (pp. 711-15) to his editorial afterword (pp. 699-711—a slightly revised version of the earlier afterword, though neither the publisher nor Bäumler calls attention to the fact that some changes have been made) Alfred Bäumler deals briefly with Karl Schlechta's and Erich Podach's criticisms of the editing of Nietzsche's Nachlass.

Chronology of Nietzsche's Works A much more comprehensive bibliography is included in my translation of *The Birth of Tragedy and The Case of Wagner*, New York, Vintage Books, 1967. Selections from the aphoristic books (1878-82) are included in *The Portable Nietzsche*, New York, The Viking Press, 1954, and in my edition of *The Genealogy of Morals and Ecce Homo*, New York, Vintage Books, 1967.

THE BIRTH OF TRAGEDY UNTIMELY MEDITATIONS David Strauss 1876 **HUMAN, ALL-TOO-HUMAN** THE DAWN THE GAY SCIENCE THUS SPOKE ZARATHUSTRA 1883-1892 Parts I and II published separately in 1883, Part III in 1884, forty copies of Part IV printed in 1885 (but only seven distributed among friends); first public ed. of Part IV, dated 1891 and published in 1892 Translation with commentary by Walter Kaufmann, 1954 (originally in *The Portable Nietzsche*). **BEYOND GOOD AND EVIL** ON THE GENEALOGY OF MORALS THE CASE OF WAGNER Translation with commentary by Walter Kaufmann, 1967. **THE TWILIGHT OF THE IDOLS** (written 1888) **THE ANTICHRIST** (written 1888) **ECCE HOMO** (written 1888) **NIETZSCHE CONTRA WAGNER** (written 1888) **THE WILL TO POWER** (Notes written 1883-1888) Hegel, G W F., itr.1, p.1, 2.1, 2.2, 4.1, 4.2, 5.1, 5.2, 5.3, 5.4, 5.5, 6.1, 7.1, 9.1; Hegelian, 4.3, 5.6 Heidegger, Martin, 2.1, 5.1 Heine, Heinrich, 2.1, 9.1, 9.2, 9.3 Helvétius, Claude Adrien Heraclitus, 5.1, 5.2, 5.3, 5.4 Herbart herd, 1.1, 1.2, 1.3, 2.1, 2.2, 2.3, 3.1, 3.2, 3.3, 3.4, 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 4.4, 4.5, 4.6, 4.7, 7.1, 8.1, 8.2, 8.3, 8.4, 8.5, 8.6, 8.7, 8.8, 8.9, 9.1, 10.1, 10.2, 10.3, 10.4, 10.5; fold; herd animal, 2.1, 2.2, 2.3, 3.4, 4.8,

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THE WILL TO POWER is a very famous and interesting book, but its stature and its reputation are two very different things. Indeed, the nature and contents of the book are as little known as its title is familiar. In a way this is odd because the book has been so widely cited and discussed; but in the history of ideas one finds perpetually that Hegel was right when he said in the preface to his first book: "What is well-known is not necessarily known merely because it is well-known." Two false views of *The Will to Power* have had their day, in turn. The first was propagated by Elisabeth Förster-Nietzsche, the philosopher's sister, when she first published the book after his death: for a long time, it was widely held to represent Nietzsche's crowning systematic achievement, to which one had to turn for his final views. Alfred Bäumler began his postscript to the handy one-volume edition of the work (Kröner's Taschenausgabe, 1 vol. 78, 1930): "The Will to Power is Nietzsche's philosophical magnum opus. All the fundamental results of his thinking are brought together in this book. The aversion of its author against systematizers must not deter us from calling this work a system."

Philosophically, Bäumler was a nobody, but the editions of Nietzsche's works for which he wrote his postscripts were the most convenient and least expensive and read very widely. Being a Nazi, Bäumler was called to Berlin as professor of philosophy after Hitler came to power. His ideas about Nietzsche were accepted not only by large numbers of Germans but also by many of Nietzsche's detractors outside Germany. Ernest Newman, for example, admits in the fourth volume of his *Life of Richard Wagner* (1946) that his account of Nietzsche relies heavily on Bäumler's "masterly epitome of Nietzsche's thinking, Nietzsche, *Der Philosoph und Politiker*"² (p. 335). After World War II this view of *The Will to Power* was discredited along with the Nazis; and in the process the book itself was discredited, too. The gist of the new view was that *The Will to Power* is not worth reading at all. The man who has done more for this new myth than anyone else is Karl Schlechta, whose edition of Nietzsche's works in three thin-paper volumes (*Werke in drei Bänden*, 1954-1956) created something of an international sensation—particularly the third volume with its odd handling of *The Will to Power* and its lengthy "Philological Postscript." A passage from the postscript makes clear what is at stake: "The Will to Power contains nothing new,

nothing that could surprise anyone who knows everything N published or intended to publish” (p. 1,403). This is as untenable as Bäumler’s view: the book contains a good deal that has no close parallel in the works Nietzsche finished; for example, but by no means only, much of the material on nihilism in Book I, some of the epistemological reflections in Book III, and the attempts at proofs of the doctrine of the eternal recurrence of the same events—and scores of brilliant formulations. But Schlechta’s express view matters much less than what he did to *The Will to Power*; and matters are further complicated by the fact that what he did and what he said he did are two different things. He did away with the systematic arrangement of the older editions and with the title *The Will to Power* and offered the material in his third volume under the heading “Aus dem Nachlass der Achtzigerjahre,” that is, “From the unpublished manuscript material of the eighties.” And he claimed that his arrangement was faithful to the manuscripts and chronological (*manuskriptgetreu-chronologisch*, p. 1,393), although in fact it is neither. This question cannot be avoided here because it would be unscholarly and perverse to reproduce the old systematic arrangement in this translation if a far superior arrangement of the material had been made available in 1956. But Schlechta’s arrangement is utterly pointless, and indeed explicable only as an over-reaction against the Bäumler view: it represents an attempt to render *The Will to Power* all but unreadable. Suppose, first of all, Schlechta’s arrangement did follow the manuscripts faithfully; even then it could not claim to be chronological. For as Schlechta himself notes in passing in his postscript (p. 1,396), Nietzsche had the habit of using over and over old notebooks that had not yet been completely filled, and of writing in them now from the front toward the back, now from the back toward the front; and sometimes he filled right-hand pages only, at other times left-hand pages only. And Erich Podach claims in *Ein Blick in Notizbücher Nietzsche’s* (“A Glance into Nietzsche’s Notebooks,” 1963) that “Nietzsche as a rule used his notebooks from back to front” (p. 8). Plainly, an arrangement that was really faithful to the manuscripts would not be an arrangement at all, but simply chaotic—and almost literally unreadable. Moreover, Podach shows in the same book (pp. 202-206) that Schlechta did not always follow the manuscripts (see my notes on sections 2 and 124 below). Nor did Schlechta merely fail to consult the manuscripts, using the printed text of the standard edition instead; he did not even make a point of consulting the twenty-odd pages of notes at the end of the 1911 edition where scores of departures from the manuscripts are registered. Even if it is granted that by taking these departures into account the present translation is philologically preferable to Schlechta’s edition, it may seem odd that the old systematic arrangement has been followed here once again. There are two reasons for this. First, for all its faults, this arrangement has the virtue of making it easy for the reader to locate passages and to read straight through a lot of notes dealing with

art or religion or the theory of knowledge. Provided one realizes that one is perusing notes and not a carefully wrought systematic work, the advantages of such an arrangement outweigh the disadvantages. But would it not have been possible to improve the systematic arrangement? This brings us to the second reason for following the old editions: there is something drastically wrong with scholarly translations that are not based on, do not correspond to, and cannot be easily checked against any original. This translation should be useful to scholars and critics, philosophers and historians, professors and students; it should be possible to cite it and also to find in it passages cited by others; and it should be easy to compare the text with readily available German editions. To remind the reader of the difference, the approximate date of composition is furnished in brackets after the number of each note, and every attempt has been made to preserve the stylistic character of the original. The temptation to complete sentences, spruce up the punctuation, and turn jottings into attractive epigrams has been resisted with a will.³ And in my notes I have called attention to passages in Nietzsche's late books in which some of these notes have been put to use—sometimes almost literally, but often with an interesting and perhaps unexpected twist. And in some notes I offer cross references to other passages in which Nietzsche takes a different tack. A generation ago, many readers might have felt that if this book did not offer Nietzsche's final system, it could surely be ignored. But now that people have become used to reading the notebooks of Gide, Kafka, and Camus, for example, without taking them for anything but what they are, there is no need to downgrade Nietzsche's notes because they are mere notes. Of course, the reason he did not use some of them in his later works, although he could have included a lot of them quite easily in a chapter of aphorisms in *Twilight of the Idols*, was that many of them did not altogether satisfy him. Whether he used or did not use them, these notes obviously do not represent his final views: in his last active year, 1888, he completed five books; during the immediately preceding two years, another two. So we clearly need not turn to his notes to find what he really thought in the end. But it is fascinating to look, as it were, into the workshop of a great thinker; and Nietzsche's notes need not fear comparison with the notes of other great writers. On the contrary. In 1901, the year after Nietzsche's death, his sister published her first version of *The Will to Power* in volume 15 of her edition of his collected works, arranging 483 notes under topical headings. In 1904 she included 200 pages of additional notes "from *The Will to Power*" in the last volume of her biography of Nietzsche, to help its sales. And in 1906 another edition of the collected works offered a new version of *The Will to Power* in two volumes: the new material was mixed in with the old, and the total number of notes now came to 1,067. In the so-called Grossoktav edition of Nietzsche's *Werke* the same 1,067 notes appear in volumes 15 and 16, and volume 16 (1911) also features an appendix which contains

“uncertain aphorisms and variants,” numbered 1,068 through 1,079; “plans, dispositions, drafts” (pp. 413-67); a postscript (pp. 471-80); a list furnishing the numbers of the notebooks in which each of the notes and drafts was found; and notes indicating small departures from the manuscripts. I have made abundant use of these notes in the pages that follow, sometimes citing the volume in which they are found as “1911.”⁴ For these notes were not reprinted in the otherwise superior Musarion edition of Nietzsche’s *Werke*, in which *The Will to Power* comprises volumes 18 and 19. The other material found in 1911 is offered in that edition, too, except that the list of the notebooks is superseded by a list giving the approximate date of composition of each of the 1,067 notes. The dates given in the following pages in brackets, immediately after the number of each note, are taken from that list. The handiest edition of the work is probably the one-volume edition in Kröner’s Taschen edition, volume 78, published in 1930 with Alfred Bäumler’s postscript (discussed above). Kröner has seen fit to reprint these Nietzsche editions, complete with Bäumler’s postscripts. On close examination, however, it appears that some changes have been made in Bäumler’s remarks about *The Will to Power*, although this is not indicated anywhere. This edition contains none of the scholarly apparatus. In 1940 Friedrich Würzbach published his own rearrangement of the notes of *The Will to Power*, under the title “The Legacy of Friedrich Nietzsche: Attempt at a new interpretation of all that happens and a revaluation of all values, from the unpublished manuscript material and arranged in accordance with Nietzsche’s intentions.”⁵ The claim that these notes rather than the books Nietzsche finished represent his legacy is as untenable as the boast that this—or any—arrangement can claim the sanction of Nietzsche’s own intentions. The bulk of Würzbach’s material was taken from *The Will to Power*, but he also included some other notes (all of them previously published in the Grossoktav edition and the Musarion edition), and he amalgamated notes of all periods, from 1870 to 1888. On pages 683-97 he furnished the dates, but he nowhere indicated the numbers of the notes in the standard edition of *The Will to Power*. This edition was translated into French but has won no acceptance in Germany or among scholars elsewhere. What needs to be said about the standard arrangement followed in the present translation I said in my Nietzsche in 1950: “To arrange the material, Frau Förster-Nietzsche chose a four-line draft left by her brother, and distributed the notes under its four headings. Nietzsche himself had discarded this draft, and there are a dozen later ones, about twenty-five in all; but none of these were briefer than this one which listed only the titles of the four projected parts and thus gave the editor the greatest possible freedom. (It was also the only draft which suggested “Zucht und Züchtung” as the title of Part IV, and Frau Förster-Nietzsche may have been charmed by these words, although her brother, as we shall see, did not consider ‘breeding’ a function of race.) His own attempt to distribute some of his notes

among the four parts of a later and more detailed plan was ignored, as was the fact that Nietzsche had abandoned the entire project of *The Will to Power* in 1888.... Moreover, the *Antichrist*, however provocative, represents a more single-minded and sustained inquiry than any of Nietzsche's other books and thus suggests that the major work of which it constitutes Part I [or at least was for a while intended to form Part I] was not meant to consist of that maze of incoherent, if extremely interesting, observations which have since been represented as his crowning achievement. While he intended to use some of this material, he evidently meant to mold it into a coherent and continuous whole; and the manner in which he utilized his notes in his other finished books makes it clear that many notes would have been given an entirely new and unexpected meaning. "The publication of *The Will to Power* as Nietzsche's final and systematic work blurred the distinction between his works and his notes and created the false impression that the aphorisms in his books are of a kind with these disjointed jottings. Ever since, *The Will to Power*, rather than the *Götzen-Dämmerung* [Twilight of the Idols], *Antichrist*, and *Ecce Homo*, has been searched for Nietzsche's final position; and those who find it strangely incoherent are led to conclude that the same must be true a fortiori of his *parva opera*. "The two most common forms of the Nietzsche legend can thus be traced back to his sister. In the manner just indicated, she unwittingly laid the foundation for the myth that Nietzsche's thought is hopelessly incoherent, ambiguous, and self-contradictory; and by bringing to her interpretation of her brother's work the heritage of her late husband [a prominent anti-Semite whose ideology Nietzsche had excoriated on many occasions], she prepared the way for the belief that Nietzsche was a proto-Nazi" (Prologue, section I). Four years later, in 1954, when I published *The Portable Nietzsche* and presented four complete works as well as selections from Nietzsche's other books, notes, and letters, all arranged in chronological order, I included a few notes from *The Will to Power* under such headings as "NOTES (1887)" with footnotes reading: "Published as part of *The Will to Power* by Nietzsche's executors." Schlechta's edition of 1956 thus did not require me to change my mind about *The Will to Power*. But it may seem odd that in the light of my own estimate of *The Will to Power* I should have decided to publish a translation. The explanation is simple. Nietzsche's late works had to be made available first of all. Toward that end I made entirely new translations of *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*, *Twilight of the Idols*, *The Antichrist*, and *Nietzsche contra Wagner* (all included in *The Portable Nietzsche*), and more recently of *Beyond Good and Evil* (with commentary, 1966), *The Birth of Tragedy and The Case of Wagner* (with commentary, 1967), and *Ecce Homo* (1967). And I collaborated on a new translation of the *Genealogy of Morals* (1967). Beginning with *Zarathustra*, then, all of Nietzsche's later works will be available in new translations. At that point *The Will to Power*

should be made accessible, too, for those who cannot read these notes in the original German. To be sure, there is an old translation, done by Anthony M. Ludovici for *The Complete Works of Friedrich Nietzsche*, edited by Dr. Oscar Levy. Originally published in 1914, the two volumes of *The Will to Power* were “revised afresh by their translator” for the edition of 1924, and reprinted without further revision in 1964. Dr. Levy was probably quite right when in a prefatory note he called Ludovici “the most gifted and conscientious of my collaborators,” but unfortunately this does not mean that Ludovici’s translations are roughly reliable. Even in the revised version, the heading of section 12, for example, refers to “Cosmopolitan Values” instead of “Cosmological Values.” Let us say that Ludovici was not a philosopher, and let it go at that. It would be pointless to multiply editorial notes in order to catalogue his mistranslations. But as long as we shall never mention him in the notes, one other example may be permissible. Section 86 begins: “Your Henrik Ibsen has become very clear to me.” Evidently confusing *deutlich* (clear) and *deutsch*, Ludovici renders this: “In my opinion, Henrik Ibsen has become very German.” Nietzsche loved brevity to the point of ellipsis and often attached exceptional weight to the nuances of the words he did put down. Without an ear for the subtlest connotations of his brilliant, sparkling German, one is bound to misunderstand him. Nietzsche is Germany’s greatest prose stylist, and his language is a delight at every turn like a poet’s—more than that of all but the very greatest poets. At the same time Nietzsche deals with intricate philosophical questions, especially but not only in *The Will to Power*, and whoever lacks either a feeling for poetry or some knowledge of these problems and their terminology is sure to come to grief in trying to fathom Nietzsche, sentence for sentence, as a translator must. Yet Nietzsche’s writings have an appeal that those of most other philosophers—and of all other German philosophers—lack. People turn to him for striking epigrams and brilliant formulations; they remember phrases out of context; indeed, he is more often than not read out of context—casually, carelessly, as if the details did not matter. If one turns to translations—whether the old ones of *The Complete Works* or the more recent paperback versions that flaunt their modernity—one usually falls victim to translators who have read him that way. In addition to all this, Nietzsche writes as a “good European” (his coinage), alluding freely to Greek and Roman, French, Italian, and German literature and history, and he uses foreign phrases when they have nuances that might easily be lost in German. If we simply rendered all such phrases into English, not only subtle shades of meaning would be lost but—ininitely more important—something of this European flavor. If we simply left them all in the original, most students would be stumped by them; hence I have offered English translations in footnotes, with apologies to those who do not need them. Occasionally, no English equivalents are offered because the meaning seems so obvious, usually because the words are

almost the same in English. Similarly, some of the men referred to are identified in notes. In all such matters compromises seem unavoidable: to identify all would be insufferable, to identify none would leave even some scholars baffled, and no mean could answer every student's needs without at the same time striking some others as superfluous. Precisely the same consideration applies to all other notes. Listing all parallel passages at every point would swell the editorial notes beyond all reason: after all, there are many indices to Nietzsche's collected works (three different ones by Richard Oehler—for the Grossoktav edition, the Musarion edition, and Kröner's Taschen edition—and one by Karl Schlechta for his edition, as well as one in English for *The Collected Works*), and my recent translations furnish indices for individual works. Moreover, cross references and indices always do harm as well as good, especially in Nietzsche's case: there is no substitute for reading his main works straight through, giving attention to the movement of his thought and to the context in which various things are said. But if no passages were cited in which Nietzsche put to use the notes his sister published posthumously in *The Will to Power*, the following pages would be as misleading as all previous editions, English and German. As it is, this translation offers a great deal of information not to be found in any German edition, though it owes a great deal to the editorial apparatus of the Grossoktav edition and a little to that of the Musarion edition. It should facilitate a better understanding of Nietzsche, of the nineteenth century, and perhaps also of some of the problems with which he dealt—and therefore of the twentieth century, too. Fall of 1885 *THE WILL TO POWER* A book for thinking, nothing else: it belongs to those for whom thinking is a delight, nothing else— That it is written in German is untimely, to say the least: I wish I had written it in French so that it might not appear to be a confirmation of the aspirations of the German Reich. The Germans of today are no thinkers any longer: something else delights and impresses them. The will to power as a principle might be intelligible to them. It is precisely among the Germans today that people think less than anywhere else. But who knows? In two generations one will no longer require the sacrifice involved in any nationalistic squandering of power and in becoming stupid. (Formerly I wished I had not written my *Zarathustra* in German.) 2 "The Philosopher and Politician [sic]," published in 1931. *BOOK ONE EUROPEAN NIHILISM* 1 (1885-1886) Toward an Outline Nihilism stands at the door: whence comes this uncanniest of all guests? Point of departure: it is an error to consider "social distress" or "physiological degeneration" or, worse, corruption, as the cause of nihilism. Ours is the most decent and compassionate age. Distress, whether of the soul, body, or intellect, cannot of itself give birth to nihilism (i.e., the radical repudiation of value, meaning, and desirability). Such distress always permits a variety of interpretations. Rather: it is in one particular interpretation, the Christian-moral one, that nihilism is rooted. The end of

Christianity—at the hands of its own morality (which cannot be replaced), which turns against the Christian God (the sense of truthfulness, developed highly by Christianity, is nauseated by the falseness and mendaciousness of all Christian interpretations of the world and of history; rebound from “God is truth” to the fanatical faith “All is false”; Buddhism of action—). Skepticism regarding morality is what is decisive. The end of the moral interpretation of the world, which no longer has any sanction after it has tried to escape into some beyond, leads to nihilism. “Everything lacks meaning” (the untenability of one interpretation of the world, upon which a tremendous amount of energy has been lavished, awakens the suspicion that all interpretations of the world are false). Buddhistic tendency, yearning for Nothing. (Indian Buddhism is not the culmination of a thoroughly moralistic development; its nihilism is therefore full of morality that is not overcome: existence as punishment, existence construed as error, error thus as a punishment—a moral valuation.) Philosophical attempts to overcome the “moral God” (Hegel, pantheism). Overcoming popular ideals: the sage; the saint; the poet. The antagonism of “true” and “beautiful” and “good”—Against “meaninglessness” on the one hand, against moral value judgments on the other: to what extent has all science and philosophy so far been influenced by moral judgments? and won’t this net us the hostility of science? Or an antiscientific mentality? Critique of Spinozism. Residues of Christian value judgments are found everywhere in socialistic and positivistic systems. A critique of Christian morality is still lacking. The nihilistic consequences of contemporary natural science (together with its attempts to escape into some beyond). The industry of its pursuit eventually leads to self-disintegration, opposition, an antiscientific mentality. Since Copernicus man has been rolling from the center toward X.* The nihilistic consequences of the ways of thinking in politics and economics, where all “principles” are practically histrionic: the air of mediocrity, wretchedness, dishonesty, etc. Nationalism. Anarchism, etc. Punishment. The redeeming class and human being are lacking—the justifiers—The nihilistic consequences of historiography and of the “practical historians,” i.e., the romantics. The position of art: its position in the modern world absolutely lacking in originality. Its decline into gloom. Goethe’s allegedly Olympian stance. Art and the preparation of nihilism: romanticism (the conclusion of Wagner’s *Nibelungen*). * Cf. *Genealogy of Morals*, third essay, section 25. BOOK TWO CRITIQUE OF THE HIGHEST VALUES HITHERTO BOOK THREE PRINCIPLES OF A NEW EVALUATION BOOK FOUR DISCIPLINE AND BREEDING* * *Zucht und Züchtung*: See my note on section 980 below; also sections 398, 462, 862, 1053; Beyond, sections 225 and 262; and the last three pages of Chapter 10 of my *Nietzsche*. Very few of Nietzsche’s notes deal with “breeding,” and the contents of Book IV therefore bear little relation to this title. The same consideration applies to the second part of Book IV:

“Dionysus” Nietzsche’s sister might have chosen a later draft instead of this one, of March 17, 1887, which put down Zucht und Züchtung as the title of Book IV (this draft consists only of the four book titles, and does not include any subdivisions). But most of the other drafts, being more detailed, would have posed even greater problems. PREFACE (Nov. 1887-March 1888) CONTENTS Neither the table of contents nor the headings in the text are Nietzsche’s; both were introduced by the German editors to create the impression of a major systematic work. They are retained here with minor modifications to assist those who want to locate notes discussing particular problems. See also the comprehensive index, made especially for this edition. Cover Title Page Copyright Dedication EDITOR’S INTRODUCTION Acknowledgments ON THE EDITIONS OF The Will to Power CHRONOLOGY OF NIETZSCHE’S WORKS FACSIMILES from Nietzsche’s manuscript NIETZSCHE’S PREFACE BOOK ONE. EUROPEAN NIHILISM I. Nihilism II. History of European Nihilism BOOK TWO. CRITIQUE OF THE HIGHEST VALUES HITHERTO I. Critique of Religion II. Critique of Morality A. Critique of Ideals B. Critique of the “Good Man,” the Saint, etc. C. Disparagement of the So-Called Evil Qualities D. Critique of the Words: Improvement, Perfecting, Elevation III. Critique of Philosophy BOOK THREE. PRINCIPLES OF A NEW EVALUATION I. The Will to Power as Knowledge II. The Will to Power in Nature A. The Organic Process B. Man III. The Will to Power as Society and Individual IV. The Will to Power as Art BOOK FOUR. DISCIPLINE AND BREEDING I. Order of Rank II. Dionysus III. The Eternal Recurrence APPENDIX: Commentary on the FACSIMILES INDEX About the Author